Mandarin, Step by Step, Character by Character

A composition-driven introduction to standard Mandarin

Adhithya Rajasekaran

Starter edition — seven short lessons in one cumulative chapter.

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How to use this starter edition

Begin with no assumed Chinese. Each section takes one small expression, teaches only the characters and sounds needed for it, shows what those characters are built from, and ends with a short retrieval prompt. There is no character list to memorise first.

Two things about Mandarin will be new to a reader coming from a European language, and this book meets both in its first chapter rather than deferring them. The first is that Chinese is written in *characters*, not letters: each one is an evenly sized block built from smaller recurring components, and words are one or more of those blocks. The second is that *pitch is part of the word*. Said on a high flat note, a falling note, or a low dipping one, the same syllable is three different words. That is not emphasis; it is as much a part of the word as a consonant.

This book is also honest about one thing it cannot do. A related language would let a new word be attached to English words the reader already owns through a shared ancestor — Spanish *gracias* to *grace* and *gratitude*. Chinese and English share no ancestor, so there are no cousins to show, and inventing some would be worse than having none. What replaces them here is the composition of the characters themselves: 好 is 女, woman, beside 子, child. That is a real and visible structure, and it does help — but it anchors a new word to knowledge you are acquiring in the same breath rather than to knowledge you already had, so it is a weaker hook than a shared ancestor would give. Where a component gloss is a traditional memory picture rather than settled history, this book says so.

Romanization (pinyin) stays beside the characters in this starter edition and will fade gradually. The variety taught is standard Mandarin in simplified characters; traditional characters are a labelled future edition, not a silent substitute.

Contents

How to use this starter edition **iii**

1 Nǐ Hǎo — Hello, Character by Character **1**
1.1 mā má mǎ mà . . . 1
1.2 你 (nǐ) . . . 2
1.3 好 (hǎo) . . . 4
1.4 你好 (nǐ hǎo) . . . 5
1.5 nǐ hǎo to ní hǎo (ní hǎo) . . . 7
1.6 好 (hào) . . . 8
1.7 Practice . . . 9

2 Reading the Greeting — One Piece at a Time **11**
2.1 人 (rén) . . . 11
2.2 亻 (rén (as a component)) . . . 13
2.3 尔 (ěr) . . . 15
2.4 你 (nǐ) . . . 16
2.5 女 (nǚ) . . . 18
2.6 子 (zǐ) . . . 20
2.7 好 (hǎo) . . . 21

3 One to Five — Where the Character Is the Count **25**
3.1 一 (yī) . . . 25
3.2 一 (yī) . . . 27
3.3 二 (èr) . . . 28
3.4 二 (èr) . . . 29
3.5 三 (sān) . . . 30
3.6 三 (sān) . . . 32
3.7 四 (sì) . . . 33
3.8 四 (sì) . . . 34
3.9 五 (wǔ) . . . 35

3.10 五 (wǔ) 37
3.11 Practice 38

4 One Box, Two Characters, and the First Thing You Can Refuse 41
4.1 口 (kǒu) 41
4.2 口 (kǒu) 43
4.3 日 (rì) 44
4.4 日 (rì) 45
4.5 不 (bù) 46
4.6 不 (bù) 48
4.7 Practice 49

5 Yes, No, and a Tone That Moves 51
5.1 是 (shì) 51
5.2 是 (shì) 53
5.3 不是 (bú shì) 54
5.4 Practice 56

6 See You Again 59
6.1 再 (zài) 59
6.2 见 (jiàn) 61
6.3 再见 (zàijiàn) 63
6.4 Practice 64

7 Good Morning, and a Rule That Declines to Fire 67
7.1 早 (zǎo) 67
7.2 上 (shàng) 69
7.3 早上 (zǎoshang) 71
7.4 早上好 (zǎoshang hǎo) 72
7.5 Practice 73

8 Saying Who You Are 75
8.1 我 (wǒ) 75
8.2 我 (wǒ) 77
8.3 名 (míng) 78
8.4 字 (zì) 80
8.5 名字 (míngzi) 81
8.6 Practice 82

9 What? 85
9.1 什 (shén) . . . 85
9.2 么 (me) . . . 87
9.3 什么 (shénme) . . . 88
9.4 Practice . . . 90

10 One Character, Two Courtesies 93
10.1 讠 (yán) . . . 93
10.2 谢 (xiè) . . . 95
10.3 谢谢 (xièxie) . . . 97
10.4 不谢 (bú xiè) . . . 98
10.5 Practice . . . 99

11 After You 103
11.1 请 (qǐng) . . . 103
11.2 请 (qǐng) . . . 105
11.3 Practice . . . 106
11.4 (practice) . . . 108
11.5 好 (hǎo, hào) . . . 109

12 People under one roof 111
12.1 人 (rén) . . . 111
12.2 女 (nǚ) . . . 112
12.3 érzi . . . 113
12.4 儿 (ér) . . . 113
12.5 儿子 (érzi) . . . 114
12.6 nǚ'ér . . . 115
12.7 女儿 (nǚ'ér) . . . 115
12.8 jiā . . . 116
12.9 家 (jiā) . . . 116
12.10 家 (jiā) . . . 117
12.11 jiārén . . . 118
12.12 家人 (jiārén) . . . 118
12.13 Practice . . . 119
12.14 Practice . . . 119

13 From study to university student 121
13.1 dà . . . 121
13.2 大 (dà) . . . 122
13.3 大 (dà) . . . 122

13.4 dàjiā 123
13.5 大家 (dàjiā) 123
13.6 xué 124
13.7 学 (xué) 124
13.8 学 (xué) 125
13.9 xuésheng 126
13.10 生 (sheng) 126
13.11 学生 (xuésheng) 127
13.12 dàxué 128
13.13 大学 (dàxué) 128
13.14 dàxuésheng 129
13.15 大学生 (dàxuésheng) 129
13.16 Practice 130
13.17 Practice 130

14 One small step into school 131
14.1 xiǎo 131
14.2 小 (xiǎo) 132
14.3 小 (xiǎo) 132
14.4 xiǎoxué 133
14.5 小学 (xiǎoxué) 133
14.6 xiǎoxuésheng 134
14.7 小学生 (xiǎoxuésheng) 134
14.8 Practice 135
14.9 Practice 135

15 A wider school map 137
15.1 zhōng 137
15.2 中 (zhōng) 138
15.3 Practice 138
15.4 zhōngxué 139
15.5 中学 (zhōngxué) 139
15.6 Practice 140
15.7 zhōngxuésheng 140
15.8 中学生 (zhōngxuésheng) 141
15.9 tóngxué 141
15.10 同 (tóng) 142
15.11 同学 (tóngxué) 142
15.12 Practice 143
15.13 shàngxué 143

15.14 上学 (shàngxué) 144
15.15 Practice 144
15.16 Practice 145
15.17 Practice 145

16 Character or language? 147
16.1 zì 147
16.2 字 (zì) 148
16.3 hànzì 148
16.4 汉 (hàn) 149
16.5 汉 (hàn) 149
16.6 汉 (hàn) 150
16.7 汉字 (hànzì) 151
16.8 hànyǔ 151
16.9 Practice 152
16.10 语 (yǔ) 152
16.11 语 (yǔ) 153
16.12 语 (yǔ) 154
16.13 汉语 (hànyǔ) 155
16.14 Practice 156
16.15 Practice 156

17 Language or country? 159
17.1 zhōngwén 159
17.2 文 (wén) 160
17.3 文 (wén) 161
17.4 文 (wén) 161
17.5 中文 (zhōngwén) 162
17.6 Practice 163
17.7 zhōngguó 163
17.8 国 (guó) 164
17.9 国 (guó) 165
17.10 国 (guó) 166
17.11 中国 (zhōngguó) 167
17.12 Practice 167
17.13 Practice 168
17.14 Practice 168
17.15 Practice 168
17.16 字 — 汉字 — 汉语 … (zì — hànzì …) 169
17.17 Practice 169

18 Looking and reading **171**
18.1 kàn . . . 171
18.2 看 (kàn) . . . 172
18.3 看 (kàn) . . . 172
18.4 看 (kàn) . . . 173
18.5 看 (kàn) . . . 174
18.6 kànjiàn . . . 175
18.7 看见 (kànjiàn) . . . 175
18.8 hǎokàn . . . 176
18.9 好看 (hǎokàn) . . . 176
18.10 Practice . . . 177
18.11 shū . . . 177
18.12 书 (shū) . . . 178
18.13 书 (shū) . . . 179
18.14 书 (shū) . . . 179
18.15 书 (shū) . . . 180
18.16 kànshū . . . 181
18.17 看书 (kànshū) . . . 181
18.18 Practice . . . 182
18.19 Practice . . . 182
18.20 Practice . . . 182
18.21 Practice . . . 183
18.22 Practice . . . 183
18.23 Practice . . . 184

19 Asking **185**
19.1 ma . . . 185
19.2 吗 (ma) . . . 186
19.3 吗 (ma) . . . 187
19.4 吗 (ma) . . . 188
19.5 吗 (ma) . . . 189
19.6 nǐ hǎo ma . . . 190
19.7 你好吗 (nǐ hǎo ma) . . . 191
19.8 Practice . . . 192
19.9 shì ma . . . 192
19.10 是吗 (shì ma) . . . 193
19.11 hǎo bu hǎo . . . 193
19.12 好不好 (hǎo bu hǎo) . . . 194
19.13 Practice . . . 195
19.14 Practice . . . 196

19.15 Practice 196
19.16 Practice 197
19.17 (practice) 197

20 Six to Ten, and the Character That Was Already Here 199
20.1 六 (liù) 199
20.2 六 (liù) 201
20.3 七 (qī) 202
20.4 七 (qī) 203
20.5 八 (bā) 204
20.6 八 (bā) 205
20.7 九 (jiǔ) 206
20.8 九 (jiǔ) 208
20.9 十 (shí) 209
20.10 十 (shí) 210
20.11 Practice 211

21 Ten Words, Ninety-Nine Numbers 213
21.1 十一 (shíyī) 213
21.2 二十 (èrshí) 214
21.3 百 (bǎi) 215
21.4 一百 (yìbǎi) 217
21.5 5 — 五 (wǔ) 218
21.6 Practice 219
21.7 Practice 219

22 The Grammar That Is Not There 221
22.1 看 — 看 — 看 (kàn) 221
22.2 我是 — 你是 — 人是 (wǒ shì) 222
22.3 书 (shū) 224
22.4 中国人 (Zhōngguó rén) 225
22.5 Practice 227

23 De — The Hinge 229
23.1 的 (de) 229
23.2 的 (de) 231
23.3 看书的人 (kàn shū de rén) 233
23.4 汉语 — 我看书 (Hànyǔ, wǒ kàn shū) 234
23.5 Practice 236

24 Have, and Count **239**
24.1 有 (yǒu) . . . 239
24.2 有 (yǒu) . . . 241
24.3 个 (gè) . . . 243
24.4 个 (gè) . . . 244
24.5 Practice . . . 246

25 Le — Finished, and Changed **249**
25.1 了 (le) . . . 249
25.2 了 (le) . . . 251
25.3 我是大学生了 (wǒ shì dàxuéshēng le) . . . 253
25.4 了 (le) . . . 254
25.5 Practice . . . 256

26 Ne and Dui **259**
26.1 呢 (ne) . . . 259
26.2 呢 (ne) . . . 261
26.3 对 (duì) . . . 263
26.4 对 (duì) . . . 264
26.5 Practice . . . 266

27 Age, and And **269**
27.1 岁 (suì) . . . 269
27.2 岁 (suì) . . . 271
27.3 和 (hé) . . . 273
27.4 和 (hé) . . . 275
27.5 Practice . . . 276

28 Xihuan — What You Like **279**
28.1 喜 (xǐ) . . . 279
28.2 欢 (huān) . . . 281
28.3 喜欢 (xǐhuan) . . . 283
28.4 你喜欢什么 (nǐ xǐhuan shénme) . . . 284
28.5 Practice . . . 286

29 Reading — Characters, Words, and a First Passage **289**
29.1 (reading) . . . 289
29.2 (reading) . . . 290
29.3 (reading) . . . 291

30 How Are You? 293
30.1 zěnmeyàng . . . 293
30.2 很 (hěn) . . . 295
30.3 很 (hěn) . . . 296
30.4 很好 (hěn hǎo) . . . 297
30.5 máng . . . 299
30.6 lèi . . . 300
30.7 hái xíng . . . 301
30.8 Practice . . . 303

31 He, She and We 305
31.1 tā . . . 305
31.2 他 (tā) . . . 306
31.3 他 (tā) . . . 307
31.4 他们 (tāmen) . . . 308
31.5 们 (men) . . . 309
31.6 我们 (wǒmen) . . . 310
31.7 你们 (nǐmen) . . . 311

32 Mum and Dad 313
32.1 妈妈 (māma) . . . 313
32.2 妈 (mā) . . . 314
32.3 bàba . . . 315
32.4 gēge . . . 316
32.5 jiějie . . . 317
32.6 dìdi . . . 318

33 The Rest of the Family 321
33.1 男 (nán) . . . 321
33.2 男 (nán) . . . 322
33.3 男人 (nánrén) . . . 324
33.4 女人 (nǚrén) . . . 325
33.5 mèimei . . . 325
33.6 háizi . . . 326

34 What You Are Called 329
34.1 叫 (jiào) . . . 329
34.2 叫 (jiào) . . . 330
34.3 nín . . . 331
34.4 xìng . . . 332

34.5 rènshi 333
34.6 péngyou 334

35 Who Does What **337**
35.1 gōngzuò 337
35.2 lǎo 338
35.3 lǎoshī 339
35.4 xiānsheng 340
35.5 zhù 341

36 Where People Come From **343**
36.1 来 (lái) 343
36.2 来 (lái) 344
36.3 Měiguó 346
36.4 Yīngguó 347
36.5 Běijīng 347
36.6 nǎ 348
36.7 (dialogue) 349

37 This One and That One **351**
37.1 这 (zhè) 351
37.2 这 (zhè) 352
37.3 这个 (zhège) 354
37.4 那 (nà) 354
37.5 那 (nà) 355
37.6 nǎge 356
37.7 那个 (nàge) 357

38 Eating **359**
38.1 吃 (chī) 359
38.2 吃 (chī) 360
38.3 饭 (fàn) 361
38.4 饭 (fàn) 362
38.5 mǐfàn 364
38.6 è 364
38.7 cài 365

39 Drinking **367**
39.1 喝 (hē) 367
39.2 喝 (hē) 368

39.3 水 (shuǐ) 370
39.4 水 (shuǐ) 371
39.5 kě 372
39.6 niúnǎi 373
39.7 chá 374

40 Fruit, Bread and Eggs 375
40.1 买 (mǎi) 375
40.2 买 (mǎi) 376
40.3 píngguǒ 377
40.4 shuǐguǒ 378
40.5 miànbāo 379
40.6 jīdàn 380

41 Paying 383
41.1 多少 (duōshao) 383
41.2 多 (duō) 384
41.3 少 (shǎo) 385
41.4 qián 387
41.5 kuài 387
41.6 tài 388
41.7 yào 389

42 In the Shop 391
42.1 dōngxi 391
42.2 mài 392
42.3 shāngdiàn 393
42.4 piányi 394
42.5 guì 395
42.6 (dialogue) 396

43 Coming and Going 397
43.1 去 (qù) 397
43.2 去 (qù) 398
43.3 huí 399
43.4 zǒu 400
43.5 chūmén 401
43.6 xuéxiào 402

44 Places in Town **405**
44.1 车 (chē) . . . 405
44.2 车 (chē) . . . 406
44.3 fàndiàn . . . 408
44.4 yīyuàn . . . 408
44.5 zuò . . . 409
44.6 chūzūchē . . . 410

45 Today and Tomorrow **413**
45.1 天 (tiān) . . . 413
45.2 天 (tiān) . . . 414
45.3 今天 (jīntiān) . . . 415
45.4 今 (jīn) . . . 416
45.5 zuótiān . . . 418
45.6 xiànzài . . . 418
45.7 míngtiān . . . 419

46 The Week **421**
46.1 星期 (xīngqī) . . . 421
46.2 星 (xīng) . . . 422
46.3 期 (qī) . . . 424
46.4 星期一 (xīngqīyī) . . . 425
46.5 shíhou . . . 426
46.6 zhōumò . . . 427
46.7 星期天 (xīngqītiān) . . . 428

47 Months and Years **429**
47.1 年 (nián) . . . 429
47.2 年 (nián) . . . 430
47.3 yuè . . . 431
47.4 明年 (míngnián) . . . 432
47.5 明 (míng) . . . 433
47.6 今年 (jīnnián) . . . 435
47.7 日期 (rìqī) . . . 435
47.8 (dialogue) . . . 436

48 Telling the Time **439**
48.1 点 (diǎn) . . . 439
48.2 点 (diǎn) . . . 440
48.3 fēn . . . 442

48.4 bàn 442
48.5 jǐ 443
48.6 děng 444

49 A Day from Morning to Night 447
49.1 上午 (shàngwǔ) 447
49.2 午 (wǔ) 448
49.3 中午 (zhōngwǔ) 449
49.4 晚上 (wǎnshang) 450
49.5 晚 (wǎn) 451
49.6 xiàwǔ 453
49.7 晚上好 (wǎnshang hǎo) 454

50 Sleeping and Waking 455
50.1 shuìjiào 455
50.2 qǐchuáng 456
50.3 xiūxi 457
50.4 shēntǐ 458
50.5 bìng 459

51 How You Feel 461
51.1 gāoxìng 461
51.2 pà 462
51.3 lěng 463
51.4 rè 464
51.5 kū 465

52 Head, Hands and Feet 467
52.1 手 (shǒu) 467
52.2 手 (shǒu) 468
52.3 tóu 470
52.4 jiǎo 470
52.5 yǎnjing 471
52.6 ěrduo 472
52.7 (dialogue) 473

53 Speaking and Hearing 475
53.1 说 (shuō) 475
53.2 说 (shuō) 476
53.3 话 (huà) 478

53.4 话 (huà) 479
53.5 tīng 480
53.6 dǒng 481
53.7 màn 482

54 Learning **483**
54.1 xuéxí 483
54.2 xiě 484
54.3 dú 485
54.4 wèn 486
54.5 kè 487

55 What You Love **489**
55.1 想 (xiǎng) 489
55.2 想 (xiǎng) 490
55.3 ài 492
55.4 diànyǐng 493
55.5 chànggē 494
55.6 kāfēi 494

56 Free Time **497**
56.1 wán 497
56.2 dǎqiú 498
56.3 yùndòng 499
56.4 pǎobù 500
56.5 xiào 501

57 At Home **503**
57.1 fángzi 503
57.2 fángjiān 504
57.3 zhuōzi 505
57.4 yǐzi 506
57.5 这儿 (zhèr) 507
57.6 (dialogue) 508
57.7 (dialogue) 508

58 Things You Carry **511**
58.1 手机 (shǒujī) 511
58.2 机 (jī) 512
58.3 bāo 513

58.4 diànnǎo 514
58.5 bēizi 515
58.6 yīfu 516

59 Clothes **519**
59.1 chuān 519
59.2 xié 520
59.3 màozi 521
59.4 kùzi 522
59.5 piàoliang 523

60 Colours **525**
60.1 白 (bái) 525
60.2 白 (bái) 526
60.3 yánsè 527
60.4 hóng 528
60.5 hēi 529
60.6 lán 530

61 Long and Short **533**
61.1 长 (cháng) 533
61.2 长 (cháng) 534
61.3 duǎn 535
61.4 gāo 536
61.5 ǎi 537
61.6 xīn 538

62 Fast, Far and Near **541**
62.1 快 (kuài) 541
62.2 快 (kuài) 542
62.3 jiù 544
62.4 yuǎn 544
62.5 jìn 545
62.6 zhīdào 546

63 On the Phone **549**
63.1 电话 (diànhuà) 549
63.2 电 (diàn) 550
63.3 打电话 (dǎ diànhuà) 551
63.4 打 (dǎ) 552

63.5 wéi . . . 553
63.6 hàomǎ . . . 554
63.7 zhǎo . . . 555
63.8 (dialogue) . . . 556

64 Asking for Help **559**
64.1 对不起 (duìbuqǐ) . . . 559
64.2 起 (qǐ) . . . 560
64.3 bāng . . . 562
64.4 bāngmáng . . . 563
64.5 jiè . . . 564
64.6 huán . . . 564

65 Excuse Me **567**
65.1 门 (mén) . . . 567
65.2 门 (mén) . . . 568
65.3 请问 (qǐngwèn) . . . 570
65.4 问 (wèn) . . . 571
65.5 bù hǎoyìsi . . . 572
65.6 kāi . . . 573
65.7 guān . . . 574

66 The Weather **577**
66.1 天气 (tiānqì) . . . 577
66.2 气 (qì) . . . 578
66.3 雨 (yǔ) . . . 579
66.4 雨 (yǔ) . . . 580
66.5 xiàyǔ . . . 582
66.6 xuě . . . 582
66.7 fēng . . . 583

67 Animals **585**
67.1 马 (mǎ) . . . 585
67.2 马 (mǎ) . . . 586
67.3 gǒu . . . 588
67.4 māo . . . 589
67.5 niǎo . . . 589
67.6 yú . . . 590

68 Out of Town **593**
68.1 山 (shān) . . . 593
68.2 山 (shān) . . . 594
68.3 星星 (xīngxing) . . . 596
68.4 cǎo . . . 596
68.5 huā . . . 597
68.6 tàiyang . . . 598

69 Meals **601**
69.1 做饭 (zuòfàn) . . . 601
69.2 做 (zuò) . . . 602
69.3 早饭 (zǎofàn) . . . 604
69.4 午饭 (wǔfàn) . . . 604
69.5 晚饭 (wǎnfàn) . . . 605
69.6 好吃 (hǎochī) . . . 606
69.7 (dialogue) . . . 607

70 More to Eat **609**
70.1 ròu . . . 609
70.2 bāozi . . . 610
70.3 miàntiáo . . . 611
70.4 jiǎozi . . . 612
70.5 tāng . . . 613

71 Tastes **615**
71.1 好喝 (hǎohē) . . . 615
71.2 tián . . . 616
71.3 là . . . 617
71.4 xián . . . 618
71.5 diǎncài . . . 619

72 Getting About **621**
72.1 火车 (huǒchē) . . . 621
72.2 火 (huǒ) . . . 622
72.3 开车 (kāichē) . . . 623
72.4 开 (kāi) . . . 624
72.5 fēijī . . . 626
72.6 lù . . . 626
72.7 dào . . . 627

73 At the Station **629**
73.1 下车 (xiàchē) 629
73.2 下 (xià) 630
73.3 上车 (shàngchē) 632
73.4 huǒchēzhàn 632
73.5 jīchǎng 633
73.6 piào 634

74 Visiting **637**
74.1 进 (jìn) 637
74.2 进 (jìn) 638
74.3 客人 (kèrén) 640
74.4 客 (kè) 641
74.5 门口 (ménkǒu) 642
74.6 huānyíng 643
74.7 jièshào 644
74.8 (dialogue) 645

75 Celebrating **647**
75.1 快乐 (kuàilè) 647
75.2 乐 (lè) 648
75.3 生日 (shēngrì) 649
75.4 dàngāo 650
75.5 lǐwù 651
75.6 sòng 652

76 Parting **655**
76.1 一会儿 (yíhuìr) 655
76.2 会 (huì) 656
76.3 明天见 (míngtiān jiàn) 657
76.4 再说 (zàishuō) 658
76.5 wǎn'ān 659
76.6 bàibai 660

77 Thanks and Replies **663**
77.1 不客气 (bú kèqi) 663
77.2 máfan 664
77.3 gǎnxiè 665
77.4 fēicháng 666
77.5 zhēn 667

78 Age and Growing Up **669**
78.1 多大 (duō dà) 669
78.2 长大 (zhǎngdà) 670
78.3 前 (qián) 671
78.4 前 (qián) 672
78.5 niánjì 674
78.6 xiǎoshíhou 675

79 At School **677**
79.1 上课 (shàngkè) 677
79.2 课 (kè) 678
79.3 下课 (xiàkè) 680
79.4 jiàoshì 680
79.5 zuòyè 681
79.6 kǎoshì 682
79.7 (dialogue) 683

80 Jobs **685**
80.1 shàngbān 685
80.2 gōngrén 686
80.3 sījī 687
80.4 yīshēng 688
80.5 gōngsī 689

81 The City **691**
81.1 里 (lǐ) 691
81.2 里 (lǐ) 692
81.3 chéngshì 694
81.4 dìfang 694
81.5 wàiguó 695
81.6 pángbiān 696

82 Behind, Left and Right **699**
82.1 hòu 699
82.2 zuǒbian 700
82.3 yòubian 701
82.4 zhōngjiān 702
82.5 duìmiàn 703

83 Running Late **705**
83.1 shíjiān . . . 705
83.2 早 (zǎo) . . . 706
83.3 马上 (mǎshàng) . . . 707
83.4 láibují . . . 708
83.5 chídào . . . 709

84 Doing Things Together **711**
84.1 一起 (yìqǐ) . . . 711
84.2 jiànmiàn . . . 712
84.3 liáotiān . . . 713
84.4 cānjiā . . . 714
84.5 zhǔnbèi . . . 715
84.6 (dialogue) . . . 716
84.7 (dialogue) . . . 716

85 Where Things Are **719**
85.1 在 (zài) . . . 719
85.2 在 (zài) . . . 720
85.3 那儿 (nàr) . . . 721
85.4 lǐbian . . . 723
85.5 wàibian . . . 724
85.6 Practice . . . 725

86 Where Is It? **727**
86.1 哪儿 (nǎr) . . . 727
86.2 哪 (nǎ) . . . 728
86.3 shàngbian . . . 730
86.4 xiàbian . . . 731
86.5 xǐshǒujiān . . . 732
86.6 Practice . . . 733

87 Is There Any? **737**
87.1 没有 (méiyǒu) . . . 737
87.2 没 (méi) . . . 738
87.3 不 — 没 (bù — méi) . . . 740
87.4 chuáng . . . 741
87.5 dēng . . . 742
87.6 yàoshi . . . 743
87.7 bīngxiāng . . . 744

87.8 Practice 745

88 Two Cups of Tea **749**
88.1 两 (liǎng) 749
88.2 两 (liǎng) 750
88.3 yī to yí ge, yì tiān (yí ge, yì tiān) 752
88.4 bēi 753
88.5 běn 754
88.6 zhāng 755
88.7 zhī 756
88.8 Practice 757

89 Give Me That **761**
89.1 给 (gěi) 761
89.2 给 (gěi) 762
89.3 做 (zuò) 764
89.4 fàng 765
89.5 dài 766
89.6 zhàn 767
89.7 Practice 768

90 What I Can Do **771**
90.1 会 (huì) 771
90.2 能 (néng) 772
90.3 能 (néng) 773
90.4 kěyǐ 775
90.5 yóuyǒng 776
90.6 Practice 777

91 What I'd Like **779**
91.1 想要 (xiǎngyào) 779
91.2 要 (yào) 780
91.3 不要 (bú yào) 782
91.4 xūyào 783
91.5 一点儿 (yìdiǎnr) 784
91.6 Practice 785

92 Me Too **787**
92.1 也 (yě) 787
92.2 也 (yě) 788

92.3 càidān 790
92.4 fúwùyuán 791
92.5 biéde 792
92.6 Practice 793

93 Too Much **797**
93.1 太好了 (tài hǎo le) 797
93.2 太 (tài) 798
93.3 有点儿 (yǒudiǎnr) 799
93.4 gānjìng 801
93.5 zāng 802
93.6 Practice 803

94 All the Same **807**
94.1 都 (dōu) 807
94.2 都 (dōu) 808
94.3 yíyàng 810
94.4 niánqīng 811
94.5 pàng 812
94.6 shòu 813
94.7 Practice 814

95 Why? **817**
95.1 为什么 (wèishénme) 817
95.2 为 (wèi) 818
95.3 yǒushì 820
95.4 dǔchē 821
95.5 wàng 822
95.6 Practice 823

96 Because **827**
96.1 因为 (yīnwèi) 827
96.2 因 (yīn) 828
96.3 suǒyǐ 829
96.4 shūfu 831
96.5 Practice 832

97 My Day in Characters **835**
97.1 小时 (xiǎoshí) 835
97.2 时 (shí) 836

97.3 měitiān 838
97.4 yǐhòu 839
97.5 (reading) 840
97.6 (my own line) 841

98 With a Clock **843**
98.1 Practice 843
98.2 (dialogue) 844

99 Getting Washed **847**
99.1 洗 (xǐ) 847
99.2 洗 (xǐ) 848
99.3 shuāyá 850
99.4 xǐliǎn 851
99.5 xǐzǎo 852
99.6 shūtóu 853

100 Around Town **855**
100.1 yínháng 855
100.2 chāoshì 856
100.3 gōngyuán 857
100.4 túshūguǎn 858
100.5 yóujú 859

101 In the Kitchen **861**
101.1 chúfáng 861
101.2 白菜 (báicài) 862
101.3 菜 (cài) 863
101.4 kuàizi 865
101.5 pánzi 865
101.6 dāo 866

102 Something to Drink **869**
102.1 yǐnliào 869
102.2 guǒzhī 870
102.3 kělè 871
102.4 píjiǔ 872
102.5 bīnggān 873

103 Using Things **875**
103.1 用 (yòng) 875
103.2 用 (yòng) 876
103.3 ná 877
103.4 rēng 878
103.5 xiū 879
103.6 huài 880

104 On the Desk **883**
104.1 本子 (běnzi) 883
104.2 本 (běn) 884
104.3 bǐ 885
104.4 qiānbǐ 886
104.5 zhǐ 887
104.6 cídiǎn 888
104.7 (dialogue) 889

105 In the Bathroom **891**
105.1 máojīn 891
105.2 yáshuā 892
105.3 yágāo 893
105.4 féizào 894
105.5 jìngzi 895

106 Stops and Stations **897**
106.1 车站 (chēzhàn) 897
106.2 站 (zhàn) 898
106.3 dìtiě 900
106.4 gōngjiāochē 901
106.5 zìxíngchē 901
106.6 qí 902

107 On the Move **905**
107.1 tiào 905
107.2 pá 906
107.3 bān 907
107.4 tíng 908
107.5 líkāi 909

108 Trying It On **911**
108.1 试 (shì) . . . 911
108.2 试 (shì) . . . 912
108.3 huàn . . . 914
108.4 shuāng . . . 915
108.5 大小 (dàxiǎo) . . . 915
108.6 héshì . . . 916

109 Screens **919**
109.1 上网 (shàngwǎng) . . . 919
109.2 网 (wǎng) . . . 920
109.3 diànshì . . . 921
109.4 zhàopiàn . . . 922
109.5 chōngdiàn . . . 923
109.6 xiàzài . . . 924

110 Things I Can Do **927**
110.1 外语 (wàiyǔ) . . . 927
110.2 外 (wài) . . . 928
110.3 gāngqín . . . 929
110.4 tán . . . 930
110.5 huàhuà . . . 931
110.6 tiàowǔ . . . 932
110.7 (dialogue) . . . 933

111 In Front and Behind **935**
111.1 前边 (qiánbian) . . . 935
111.2 边 (biān) . . . 936
111.3 hòubian . . . 937
111.4 fùjìn . . . 938
111.5 lùkǒu . . . 939
111.6 guǎi . . . 940

112 Way In, Way Out **943**
112.1 出口 (chūkǒu) . . . 943
112.2 出 (chū) . . . 944
112.3 rùkǒu . . . 945
112.4 tuī . . . 946
112.5 lā . . . 947
112.6 lóutī . . . 948

113 Cooking **951**
113.1 qiē . . . 951
113.2 zhǔ . . . 952
113.3 chǎo . . . 953
113.4 kǎo . . . 954
113.5 jiān . . . 955

114 Paying **957**
114.1 mǎidān . . . 957
114.2 fù . . . 958
114.3 xiànjīn . . . 959
114.4 shuākǎ . . . 960
114.5 zhǎoqián . . . 961

115 Careful! **963**
115.1 小心 (xiǎoxīn) . . . 963
115.2 心 (xīn) . . . 964
115.3 xīyān . . . 965
115.4 jìnzhǐ . . . 966
115.5 zhùyì . . . 967
115.6 wēixiǎn . . . 968

116 Things I Carry **971**
116.1 qiánbāo . . . 971
116.2 hùzhào . . . 972
116.3 shǒubiǎo . . . 973
116.4 yǔsǎn . . . 974
116.5 diū . . . 975
116.6 (dialogue) . . . 976

117 Which Way? **977**
117.1 dōngbian . . . 977
117.2 nánbian . . . 978
117.3 xībian . . . 979
117.4 běibian . . . 980
117.5 fāngxiàng . . . 981

118 Sending Things **983**
118.1 bāoguǒ . . . 983
118.2 jì . . . 984

118.3 xìn 985
118.4 duǎnxìn 986
118.5 shōu 987

119 Bags and Boxes 989
119.1 书包 (shūbāo) 989
119.2 包 (bāo) 990
119.3 xiāngzi 991
119.4 hézi 992
119.5 dàizi 993
119.6 xíngli 994

120 Takeaway 997
120.1 wàimài 997
120.2 dìng 998
120.3 dìzhǐ 999
120.4 打包 (dǎbāo) 1000
120.5 点心 (diǎnxin) 1001

121 Teaching and Practising 1003
121.1 jiāo 1003
121.2 liànxí 1004
121.3 huídá 1005
121.4 fùxí 1006
121.5 cuò 1007

122 Opening Hours 1009
122.1 yíngyè 1009
122.2 kāishǐ 1010
122.3 jiéshù 1011
122.4 shíkèbiǎo 1012
122.5 dǎzhé 1013
122.6 (dialogue) 1014
122.7 (dialogue) 1015

123 What People Are Like 1017
123.1 cōngming 1017
123.2 rènzhēn 1018
123.3 kě'ài 1019
123.4 rèqíng 1020

123.5 guānxīn 1021

124 Tall and Handsome 1023
124.1 个子 (gèzi) 1023
124.2 tóufa 1024
124.3 shuài 1025
124.4 nánkàn 1026
124.5 xiàng 1027

125 Angry and Worried 1029
125.1 生气 (shēngqì) 1029
125.2 dānxīn 1030
125.3 fàngxīn 1031
125.4 zháojí 1032
125.5 nánguò 1033

126 Often and Sometimes 1035
126.1 chángcháng 1035
126.2 yǒushíhou 1036
126.3 以前 (yǐqián) 1037
126.4 以 (yǐ) 1038
126.5 gāngcái 1039
126.6 yǐjīng 1040

127 These and Those 1043
127.1 这些 (zhèxiē) 1043
127.2 些 (xiē) 1044
127.3 那些 (nàxiē) 1046
127.4 哪些 (nǎxiē) 1046
127.5 一些 (yìxiē) 1047
127.6 zhèyàng 1048

128 Music 1051
128.1 音乐 (yīnyuè) 1051
128.2 音 (yīn) 1052
128.3 gē 1054
128.4 hǎotīng 1055
128.5 音乐会 (yīnyuèhuì) 1055
128.6 jítā 1056
128.7 (dialogue) 1057

129 Quiet and Noisy **1059**
129.1 ānjìng . . . 1059
129.2 吵 (chǎo) . . . 1060
129.3 吵 (chǎo) . . . 1061
129.4 rènao . . . 1063
129.5 fāngbiàn . . . 1063
129.6 yǒuyìsi . . . 1064

130 Feeling Ill **1067**
130.1 病人 (bìngrén) . . . 1067
130.2 病 (bìng) . . . 1068
130.3 gǎnmào . . . 1070
130.4 fāshāo . . . 1071
130.5 téng . . . 1071
130.6 看病 (kànbìng) . . . 1072

131 Four Seasons **1075**
131.1 春天 (chūntiān) . . . 1075
131.2 春 (chūn) . . . 1076
131.3 xiàtiān . . . 1078
131.4 qiūtiān . . . 1078
131.5 dōngtiān . . . 1079
131.6 jìjié . . . 1080

132 Thousands **1083**
132.1 千 (qiān) . . . 1083
132.2 千 (qiān) . . . 1084
132.3 wàn . . . 1086
132.4 líng . . . 1087
132.5 yígòng . . . 1087
132.6 shǔ . . . 1088

133 Housework **1091**
133.1 打扫 (dǎsǎo) . . . 1091
133.2 扫 (sǎo) . . . 1092
133.3 jiāwù . . . 1093
133.4 shōushi . . . 1094
133.5 cā . . . 1095
133.6 dié . . . 1096

134 Heavy and Soft **1099**
134.1 重 (zhòng) 1099
134.2 重 (zhòng) 1100
134.3 ruǎn 1102
134.4 yìng 1102
134.5 kōng 1103
134.6 mǎn 1104
134.7 (dialogue) 1105

135 Sport **1107**
135.1 zúqiú 1107
135.2 lánqiú 1108
135.3 tī 1109
135.4 bǐsài 1110
135.5 duànliàn 1111

136 Because of the Weather **1113**
136.1 qíngtiān 1113
136.2 yīntiān 1114
136.3 guāfēng 1115
136.4 dǎléi 1116
136.5 liángkuai 1117

137 Holidays **1119**
137.1 节日 (jiérì) 1119
137.2 节 (jié) 1120
137.3 春节 (Chūnjié) 1122
137.4 guònián 1123
137.5 fàngjià 1124
137.6 jiàqī 1124

138 Every and Other **1127**
138.1 每 (měi) 1127
138.2 每 (měi) 1128
138.3 zìjǐ 1130
138.4 biérén 1131
138.5 suǒyǒu 1131
138.6 qítā 1132

139 Colours and Shapes **1135**
139.1 lǜ . . . 1135
139.2 huáng . . . 1136
139.3 huī . . . 1137
139.4 yuán . . . 1138
139.5 fěnhóng . . . 1139

140 First and Half **1141**
140.1 dìyī . . . 1141
140.2 一半 (yíbàn) . . . 1142
140.3 半 (bàn) . . . 1143
140.4 cì . . . 1144
140.5 zuì . . . 1145
140.6 suàn . . . 1146
140.7 (dialogue) . . . 1147

141 Travel and Fun **1149**
141.1 lǚyóu . . . 1149
141.2 yóuxì . . . 1150
141.3 guàngjiē . . . 1151
141.4 sànbù . . . 1152
141.5 diàoyú . . . 1153

142 More Housework **1155**
142.1 tuōdì . . . 1155
142.2 lājī . . . 1156
142.3 shài . . . 1157
142.4 zhěnglǐ . . . 1158
142.5 jiāohuā . . . 1159

143 Clock Words **1161**
143.1 miǎo . . . 1161
143.2 fēnzhōng . . . 1162
143.3 chà . . . 1163
143.4 zhǔnshí . . . 1164
143.5 半天 (bàntiān) . . . 1165

144 Easy and Important **1167**
144.1 重要 (zhòngyào) . . . 1167
144.2 róngyì . . . 1168

144.3 jiǎndān 1169
144.4 tèbié 1170
144.5 juéde 1171

145 Late Again **1173**
145.1 yuányīn 1173
145.2 晚点 (wǎndiǎn) 1174
145.3 nàozhōng 1175
145.4 shuì lǎnjiào 1176
145.5 gǎnkuài 1177

146 Day and Night **1179**
146.1 白天 (báitiān) 1179
146.2 yèli 1180
146.3 bànyè 1181
146.4 xǐng 1182
146.5 píngshí 1183
146.6 (dialogue) 1184
146.7 (dialogue) 1184

147 It Might Rain **1187**
147.1 后天 (hòutiān) 1187
147.2 后 (hòu) 1188
147.3 明天会下雨 (míngtiān huì xiàyǔ) 1190
147.4 kěnéng 1191
147.5 yídìng 1192
147.6 tiānqì yùbào 1193
147.7 Practice 1194

148 Next Month **1197**
148.1 下个月 (xià ge yuè) 1197
148.2 月 (yuè) 1198
148.3 火车要开了 (huǒchē yào kāi le) 1200
148.4 下星期 (xià xīngqī) 1201
148.5 上个月 (shàng ge yuè) 1202
148.6 dǎsuàn 1203
148.7 jiānglái 1204
148.8 Practice 1206

149 Right Now **1209**
149.1 正在 (zhèngzài) 1209
149.2 正 (zhèng) 1210
149.3 你在做什么 (nǐ zài zuò shénme) 1212
149.4 正好 (zhènghǎo) 1213
149.5 一边 (yìbiān) 1214
149.6 Practice 1215

150 Have You Ever Been? **1219**
150.1 过去 (guòqù) 1219
150.2 过 (guò) 1220
150.3 你去过中国吗 (nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma) 1222
150.4 后来 (hòulái) 1223
150.5 ránhòu 1224
150.6 cónglái 1225
150.7 Practice 1226

151 Seen and Understood **1229**
151.1 看到 (kàndào) 1229
151.2 到 (dào) 1230
151.3 看到 — 没看到 (kàndào — méi kàndào) 1232
151.4 学会 (xuéhuì) 1233
151.5 tīngdǒng 1234
151.6 kàndǒng 1235
151.7 zuòwán 1236
151.8 Practice 1238

152 Well Said **1241**
152.1 得 (de) 1241
152.2 得 (de) 1242
152.3 你说得很好 (nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo) 1244
152.4 liúlì 1245
152.5 búcuò 1246
152.6 qīngchu 1247
152.7 Practice 1248

153 Older Than Me **1251**
153.1 比 (bǐ) 1251
153.2 比 (bǐ) 1252
153.3 他比我大两岁 (tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì) 1254

153.4 gèng 1255
153.5 gēn 1256
153.6 那么 (nàme) 1257
153.7 Practice 1258

154 This One or That One 1261
154.1 还 (hái) 1261
154.2 还 (hái) 1262
154.3 还是 (háishi) 1264
154.4 huòzhě 1265
154.5 bié 1266
154.6 Practice 1267

155 Trains and Opening Hours 1271
155.1 从 (cóng) 1271
155.2 从 (cóng) 1272
155.3 从八点到十点 (cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn) 1274
155.4 chūfā 1275
155.5 开门 (kāimén) 1276
155.6 guānmén 1277
155.7 (reading) 1278
155.8 Practice 1279

156 Price List 1283
156.1 元 (yuán) 1283
156.2 元 (yuán) 1284
156.3 jiàqián 1285
156.4 miǎnfèi 1287
156.5 guǎnggào 1288
156.6 (reading) 1289
156.7 Practice 1290

157 A Note About Tomorrow 1293
157.1 开会 (kāihuì) 1293
157.2 tōngzhī 1294
157.3 xiāoxi 1296
157.4 huífù 1297
157.5 (reading) 1298
157.6 (a reply) 1299
157.7 (dialogue) 1300

158 Waking Up **1305**
158.1 jiàoxǐng . . . 1305
158.2 shuìzháo . . . 1306
158.3 zuòmèng . . . 1307
158.4 起来 (qǐlai) . . . 1308
158.5 xíguàn . . . 1309

159 Rooms at Home **1311**
159.1 wòshì . . . 1311
159.2 kètīng . . . 1312
159.3 书房 (shūfáng) . . . 1313
159.4 房 (fáng) . . . 1314
159.5 yángtái . . . 1316
159.6 chuānghu . . . 1317

160 Doing the Chores **1319**
160.1 sǎodì . . . 1319
160.2 xǐwǎn . . . 1320
160.3 pūchuáng . . . 1321
160.4 gànhuó . . . 1322
160.5 zhàogù . . . 1323

161 Rice and Meat **1325**
161.1 大米 (dàmǐ) . . . 1325
161.2 米 (mǐ) . . . 1326
161.3 fèn . . . 1327
161.4 chǎofàn . . . 1328
161.5 niúròu . . . 1329
161.6 jīròu . . . 1330

162 How Often **1333**
162.1 yìbān . . . 1333
162.2 zǒngshì . . . 1334
162.3 jīngcháng . . . 1335
162.4 ǒu'ěr . . . 1336
162.5 tōngcháng . . . 1337

163 Free This Weekend **1339**
163.1 yǒukòng . . . 1339
163.2 péi . . . 1340

163.3 yěcān 1341
163.4 xià cì 1342
163.5 yíkuàir 1343
163.6 (dialogue) 1344

164 Getting Ready **1347**
164.1 dǎban 1347
164.2 xǐtóu 1348
164.3 chuīfēngjī 1349
164.4 huàzhuāng 1350
164.5 guāliǎn 1351

165 Coats and Scarves **1353**
165.1 大衣 (dàyī) 1353
165.2 衣 (yī) 1354
165.3 máoyī 1355
165.4 tiáo 1356
165.5 qúnzi 1357
165.6 wéijīn 1358

166 Tea Time **1361**
166.1 开水 (kāishuǐ) 1361
166.2 下午茶 (xiàwǔchá) 1362
166.3 茶 (chá) 1363
166.4 hóngchá 1365
166.5 cháyè 1365
166.6 pàochá 1366

167 The Day Before Yesterday **1369**
167.1 前天 (qiántiān) 1369
167.2 fāshēng 1370
167.3 没事 (méishì) 1371
167.4 事 (shì) 1372
167.5 tíngdiàn 1374
167.6 shēngyīn 1375

168 Steamed or Fried **1377**
168.1 zhēng 1377
168.2 zhá 1378
168.3 dùn 1379

168.4 shāoshuǐ 1380
168.5 táng 1381

169 Early and Late 1383
169.1 一大早 (yídàzǎo) 1383
169.2 午觉 (wǔjiào) 1384
169.3 觉 (jiào) 1385
169.4 bàngwǎn 1387
169.5 áoyè 1388
169.6 shēnyè 1389
169.7 (dialogue) 1389

170 Pots and Pans 1391
170.1 guō 1391
170.2 茶杯 (chábēi) 1392
170.3 杯 (bēi) 1393
170.4 sháozi 1394
170.5 chāzi 1395
170.6 wēibōlú 1396

171 Switching Things On 1399
171.1 打开 (dǎkāi) 1399
171.2 kōngtiáo 1400
171.3 yáokòngqì 1401
171.4 àn 1402
171.5 pèng 1403

172 Sweet and Sour 1405
172.1 wèidao 1405
172.2 suān 1406
172.3 kǔ 1407
172.4 xiāng 1408
172.5 dàn 1409

173 An Invitation 1411
173.1 yāoqǐng 1411
173.2 问候 (wènhòu) 1412
173.3 候 (hòu) 1413
173.4 晚会 (wǎnhuì) 1415
173.5 jùhuì 1416

173.6 请客 (qǐngkè) 1417

174 Jobs Around the House 1419
174.1 guà 1419
174.2 nòng 1420
174.3 tái 1421
174.4 tīzi 1422
174.5 dēngpào 1423

175 Sofa and Shelves 1425
175.1 jiājù 1425
175.2 shāfā 1426
175.3 面前 (miànqián) 1427
175.4 面 (miàn) 1428
175.5 guìzi 1430
175.6 shūjià 1431
175.7 (dialogue) 1431

176 A Knock at the Door 1433
176.1 qiāomén 1433
176.2 línjū 1434
176.3 chǎojià 1435
176.4 dǎo 1436
176.5 zháohuǒ 1437

177 Full Already 1439
177.1 tuījiàn 1439
177.2 dòufu 1440
177.3 bǎo 1441
177.4 xīnxiān 1442
177.5 nánchī 1443

178 An Ordinary Day 1445
178.1 正常 (zhèngcháng) 1445
178.2 常 (cháng) 1446
178.3 日子 (rìzi) 1448
178.4 从前 (cóngqián) 1449
178.5 zuìjìn 1450
178.6 língchén 1451

179 Laundry Day **1453**
179.1 洗衣机 (xǐyījī) 1453
179.2 xǐyīfěn 1454
179.3 liàng 1455
179.4 yùn 1456
179.5 yīguì 1457

180 Coming Over **1459**
180.1 做客 (zuòkè) 1459
180.2 zhǔrén 1460
180.3 kànwàng 1461
180.4 过来 (guòlai) 1462
180.5 yuē 1463

181 Bed and Bath **1465**
181.1 bèizi 1465
181.2 zhěntou 1466
181.3 间 (jiān) 1467
181.4 间 (jiān) 1468
181.5 yùshì 1469
181.6 chuānglián 1470
181.7 (dialogue) 1471

182 Eating Out **1473**
182.1 fànguǎn 1473
182.2 冷菜 (lěngcài) 1474
182.3 冷 (lěng) 1475
182.4 小吃 (xiǎochī) 1477
182.5 家常菜 (jiāchángcài) 1478
182.6 héfàn 1479

183 In and Out **1481**
183.1 出去 (chūqù) 1481
183.2 进来 (jìnlái) 1482
183.3 xiàbān 1483
183.4 suǒmén 1484
183.5 tǎng 1485

184 Holiday Plans **1487**
184.1 dùjià . . . 1487
184.2 juédìng . . . 1488
184.3 cānguān . . . 1489
184.4 lǎojiā . . . 1490
184.5 fàngsōng . . . 1491

185 Long Ago and Soon **1493**
185.1 hǎojiǔ . . . 1493
185.2 zhīqián . . . 1494
185.3 zhīhòu . . . 1495
185.4 早晚 (zǎowǎn) . . . 1496
185.5 wǎngwǎng . . . 1497

186 Odds and Ends **1499**
186.1 jiǎndāo . . . 1499
186.2 lājītǒng . . . 1500
186.3 sùliàodài . . . 1501
186.4 píngzi . . . 1502
186.5 chōuti . . . 1503

187 What a Day **1505**
187.1 dǎpò . . . 1505
187.2 shuāi . . . 1506
187.3 hòuhuǐ . . . 1507
187.4 dāngshí . . . 1508
187.5 jiéguǒ . . . 1509
187.6 (dialogue) . . . 1510
187.7 (dialogue) . . . 1511

188 Money to Spend **1513**
188.1 有钱 (yǒuqián) . . . 1513
188.2 钱 (qián) . . . 1514
188.3 huāqián . . . 1516
188.4 língqián . . . 1517
188.5 shěngqián . . . 1518
188.6 gòu . . . 1519

189 Forms and Dates **1521**
189.1 号 (hào) 1521
189.2 号 (hào) 1522
189.3 biǎogé 1523
189.4 tiánxiě 1524
189.5 qiānmíng 1525
189.6 shēnfènzhèng 1526

190 Shops in Town **1529**
190.1 书店 (shūdiàn) 1529
190.2 店 (diàn) 1530
190.3 yàodiàn 1532
190.4 shāngchǎng 1533
190.5 diànyǐngyuàn 1534
190.6 bówùguǎn 1535

191 Back Next Month **1537**
191.1 回来 (huílái) 1537
191.2 回 (huí) 1538
191.3 回去 (huíqù) 1539
191.4 回国 (huíguó) 1540
191.5 出国 (chūguó) 1541
191.6 chūchāi 1542

192 Signs in a Building **1545**
192.1 cèsuǒ 1545
192.2 diàntī 1546
192.3 tíngchēchǎng 1547
192.4 páiduì 1548
192.5 kāifàng 1549

193 Prices Up and Down **1551**
193.1 tèjià 1551
193.2 jiàngjià 1552
193.3 zhǎngjià 1553
193.4 jiǎngjià 1554
193.5 zhìliàng 1555
193.6 (dialogue) 1556

194 Roads and Crossings 1559
194.1 马路 (mǎlù) 1559
194.2 路 (lù) 1560
194.3 zǒulù 1562
194.4 bānmǎxiàn 1563
194.5 guǎngchǎng 1564
194.6 hónglǜdēng 1565

195 At the Bank 1567
195.1 cúnqián 1567
195.2 qǔqián 1568
195.3 xìnyòngkǎ 1569
195.4 mìmǎ 1570
195.5 zhànghù 1571

196 Tickets and Flights 1573
196.1 车票 (chēpiào) 1573
196.2 票 (piào) 1574
196.3 机票 (jīpiào) 1576
196.4 hángbān 1576
196.5 qǐfēi 1577
196.6 dàodá 1578

197 Finding the Way 1581
197.1 问路 (wènlù) 1581
197.2 找到 (zhǎodào) 1582
197.3 找 (zhǎo) 1583
197.4 mílù 1584
197.5 yìzhí 1585
197.6 lùxiàn 1586

198 Phones and Messages 1589
198.1 关机 (guānjī) 1589
198.2 关 (guān) 1590
198.3 开机 (kāijī) 1591
198.4 liúyán 1592
198.5 zhànxiàn 1593
198.6 xìnhào 1594

199 Sizes **1597**
199.1 chǐmǎ . . . 1597
199.2 báo . . . 1598
199.3 féi . . . 1599
199.4 jǐn . . . 1600
199.5 tiāo . . . 1601
199.6 (dialogue) . . . 1602

200 Booking a Room **1605**
200.1 bīnguǎn . . . 1605
200.2 yùdìng . . . 1606
200.3 dānrénjiān . . . 1607
200.4 rùzhù . . . 1608
200.5 tuìfáng . . . 1609

201 Post and Parcels **1611**
201.1 yóupiào . . . 1611
201.2 kuàidì . . . 1612
201.3 yóujiàn . . . 1613
201.4 fāsòng . . . 1614
201.5 shōudào . . . 1615

202 At the Till **1617**
202.1 sǎomǎ . . . 1617
202.2 shōujù . . . 1618
202.3 tuìhuò . . . 1619
202.4 gùkè . . . 1620
202.5 shōuyíntái . . . 1621

203 Renting a Flat **1623**
203.1 zū . . . 1623
203.2 房东 (fángdōng) . . . 1624
203.3 东 (dōng) . . . 1625
203.4 fángzū . . . 1627
203.5 yājīn . . . 1627
203.6 hétong . . . 1628

204 Online **1631**
204.1 网站 (wǎngzhàn) . . . 1631
204.2 dēnglù . . . 1632

204.3 diǎnjī . . . 1633
204.4 shìpín . . . 1634
204.5 打字 (dǎzì) . . . 1635

205 How Far Is It? 1637
205.1 离 (lí) . . . 1637
205.2 离 (lí) . . . 1638
205.3 公里 (gōnglǐ) . . . 1640
205.4 公 (gōng) . . . 1641
205.5 zuǒyòu . . . 1642
205.6 chàbuduō . . . 1643
205.7 jùlí . . . 1644
205.8 (dialogue) . . . 1645

206 Upstairs 1647
206.1 lóu . . . 1647
206.2 céng . . . 1648
206.3 shànglóu . . . 1649
206.4 bàngōngshì . . . 1650
206.5 qiántái . . . 1651

207 Where and When 1653
207.1 地点 (dìdiǎn) . . . 1653
207.2 地 (dì) . . . 1654
207.3 jìhuà . . . 1655
207.4 ānpái . . . 1656
207.5 zhàoxiàng . . . 1657
207.6 jǐngdiǎn . . . 1658

208 Getting Things Fixed 1661
208.1 shīfu . . . 1661
208.2 jiǎnchá . . . 1662
208.3 ānzhuāng . . . 1663
208.4 gōngjù . . . 1664
208.5 diànchí . . . 1665

209 Rules and Notices 1667
209.1 guīdìng . . . 1667
209.2 ānquán . . . 1668
209.3 bǎochí . . . 1669

209.4 dǎrǎo 1670
209.5 yǔnxǔ 1671

210 Colours and Styles 1673
210.1 zǐsè 1673
210.2 zōngsè 1674
210.3 kuǎnshì 1675
210.4 试衣间 (shìyījiān) 1676
210.5 xuǎn 1677

211 Local or From Out of Town 1679
211.1 本地 (běndì) 1679
211.2 外地 (wàidì) 1680
211.3 shìzhōngxīn 1681
211.4 dìtú 1682
211.5 dàochù 1683
211.6 (dialogue) 1684

212 Services in Town 1687
212.1 dǎyìn 1687
212.2 fùyìn 1688
212.3 chōngzhí 1689
212.4 yùyuē 1690
212.5 lǐfà 1691

213 A Trip Abroad 1693
213.1 qiānzhèng 1693
213.2 dǎoyóu 1694
213.3 yóukè 1695
213.4 门票 (ménpiào) 1696
213.5 yílù píng'ān 1697

214 Asking for Help 1699
214.1 wèntí 1699
214.2 gàosu 1700
214.3 明白 (míngbai) 1701
214.4 bànfǎ 1702
214.5 zěnme bàn 1703

215 Deliveries and the Laundry **1705**
215.1 sònghuò . . . 1705
215.2 qiānshōu . . . 1706
215.3 jìcún . . . 1707
215.4 洗衣店 (xǐyīdiàn) . . . 1708
215.5 gānxǐ . . . 1709

216 Something Has Gone Wrong **1711**
216.1 zāogāo . . . 1711
216.2 qíguài . . . 1712
216.3 tōu . . . 1713
216.4 jǐngchá . . . 1714
216.5 bàojǐng . . . 1715

217 Never Mind **1717**
217.1 méi guānxi . . . 1717
217.2 dāngrán . . . 1718
217.3 jìde . . . 1719
217.4 dǎting . . . 1720
217.5 jiějué . . . 1721
217.6 (dialogue) . . . 1722
217.7 (dialogue) . . . 1723

218 Wind and Warm Days **1725**
218.1 风衣 (fēngyī) . . . 1725
218.2 风 (fēng) . . . 1726
218.3 nuǎnhuo . . . 1728
218.4 mēnrè . . . 1729
218.5 gānzào . . . 1730
218.6 cháoshī . . . 1730

219 Cloudy Tomorrow **1733**
219.1 云 (yún) . . . 1733
219.2 云 (yún) . . . 1734
219.3 多云 (duōyún) . . . 1736
219.4 jiàngwēn . . . 1736
219.5 qìwēn . . . 1737
219.6 fàngqíng . . . 1738

220 Keeping Fit **1741**
220.1 jiànshēn 1741
220.2 jiǎnféi 1742
220.3 chūhàn 1743
220.4 tiàoshéng 1744
220.5 zuòcāo 1745

221 Snow and Ice **1747**
221.1 雪人 (xuěrén) 1747
221.2 雪 (xuě) 1748
221.3 huáxuě 1750
221.4 bīng 1751
221.5 língxià 1751
221.6 shǒutào 1752

222 Under the Weather **1755**
222.1 zháoliáng 1755
222.2 késou 1756
222.3 sǎngzi 1757
222.4 dǎ pēntì 1758
222.5 nánshòu 1759

223 Animals **1761**
223.1 dòngwù 1761
223.2 xióngmāo 1762
223.3 lǎohǔ 1763
223.4 hóuzi 1764
223.5 tùzi 1765
223.6 (dialogue) 1766

224 Spring Flowers **1767**
224.1 开花 (kāihuā) 1767
224.2 花 (huā) 1768
224.3 花店 (huādiàn) 1770
224.4 huāyuán 1771
224.5 húdié 1772
224.6 mìfēng 1773

225 In the Country **1775**
225.1 nóngcūn 1775
225.2 nóngmín 1776
225.3 zhòngdì 1777
225.4 zhāi 1778
225.5 lùyíng 1779

226 Grass and Lakes **1781**
226.1 草地 (cǎodì) 1781
226.2 草 (cǎo) 1782
226.3 hú 1784
226.4 sēnlín 1784
226.5 cǎoyuán 1785
226.6 fēngjǐng 1786

227 A Day at the Sea **1789**
227.1 hǎibiān 1789
227.2 chuán 1790
227.3 yùnchuán 1791
227.4 shātān 1792
227.5 yùdào 1793

228 A Headache **1795**
228.1 头疼 (tóuténg) 1795
228.2 头 (tóu) 1796
228.3 疼 (téng) 1797
228.4 chīyào 1799
228.5 dǎzhēn 1800
228.6 yánzhòng 1801
228.7 点头 (diǎntóu) 1802

229 Keeping a Pet **1803**
229.1 chǒngwù 1803
229.2 yǎng 1804
229.3 liùgǒu 1805
229.4 zhuā 1806
229.5 mō 1807
229.6 (dialogue) 1808

230 Head to Toe **1811**
230.1 身上 (shēnshang) 1811
230.2 身 (shēn) 1812
230.3 体重 (tǐzhòng) 1814
230.4 体 (tǐ) 1815
230.5 dùzi 1816
230.6 bízi 1817
230.7 tuǐ 1818

231 Seeing a Doctor **1821**
231.1 中医 (zhōngyī) 1821
231.2 医 (yī) 1822
231.3 西医 (xīyī) 1824
231.4 西 (xī) 1825
231.5 guàhào 1826
231.6 hùshi 1827
231.7 kāiyào 1828

232 An Accident **1831**
232.1 出事 (chūshì) 1831
232.2 shòushāng 1832
232.3 liúxuè 1833
232.4 zhuàng 1834
232.5 jiùhùchē 1835

233 How People Look **1837**
233.1 yàngzi 1837
233.2 yǎnjìng 1838
233.3 húzi 1839
233.4 miáotiao 1840
233.5 pífū 1841

234 Rain or Shine **1843**
234.1 tuīchí 1843
234.2 qǔxiāo 1844
234.3 gǎitiān 1845
234.4 雨衣 (yǔyī) 1846
234.5 duǒyǔ 1847

235 For a Reason **1849**
235.1 为了 (wèile) 1849
235.2 yóuyú 1850
235.3 lǐyóu 1851
235.4 zhǐhǎo 1852
235.5 guàibude 1853
235.6 (dialogue) 1854

236 Something Odd **1857**
236.1 出现 (chūxiàn) 1857
236.2 现 (xiàn) 1858
236.3 fāxiàn 1860
236.4 hàipà 1861
236.5 xìnghǎo 1861
236.6 chàdiǎnr 1862

237 Plants **1865**
237.1 zhíwù 1865
237.2 花生 (huāshēng) 1866
237.3 yèzi 1867
237.4 fāyá 1868
237.5 xīguā 1869

238 Sea and Sky **1871**
238.1 tiānkōng 1871
238.2 yuèliang 1872
238.3 wūyún 1873
238.4 dàhǎi 1874
238.5 cǎihóng 1875

239 Healthy Habits **1877**
239.1 jiànkāng 1877
239.2 jièyān 1878
239.3 hējiǔ 1879
239.4 hūxī 1880
239.5 tǐjiǎn 1881

240 Feeling Ill **1883**
240.1 生病 (shēngbìng) 1883
240.2 fāyán 1884

240.3 zhǒng 1885
240.4 tù 1886
240.5 lā dùzi 1887

241 In Hospital 1889
241.1 zhùyuàn 1889
241.2 病房 (bìngfáng) 1890
241.3 shǒushù 1891
241.4 chūyuàn 1892
241.5 huīfù 1893
241.6 (dialogue) 1894

242 Farm Animals and Bugs 1897
242.1 zhū 1897
242.2 shānyáng 1898
242.3 shé 1899
242.4 chóngzi 1900
242.5 wénzi 1901

243 Changing Seasons 1903
243.1 气候 (qìhòu) 1903
243.2 雪花 (xuěhuā) 1904
243.3 biànhuà 1905
243.4 jiébīng 1906
243.5 wēndù 1907

244 A Storm Coming 1909
244.1 táifēng 1909
244.2 zhènyǔ 1910
244.3 shuōbudìng 1911
244.4 wànyī 1912
244.5 jìxù 1913

245 Take Care 1915
245.1 tǐwēn 1915
245.2 chuánrǎn 1916
245.3 kǒuzhào 1917
245.4 xīnqíng 1918
245.5 bǎozhòng 1919

246 Out in the Hills 1921
246.1 cūnzi . . . 1921
246.2 qiáo . . . 1922
246.3 shítou . . . 1923
246.4 chítáng . . . 1924
246.5 huáchuán . . . 1925

247 Back From a Trip 1927
247.1 jīnglì . . . 1927
247.2 yúkuài . . . 1928
247.3 tèchǎn . . . 1929
247.4 jìniànpǐn . . . 1930
247.5 huíyì . . . 1931
247.6 (dialogue) . . . 1932
247.7 (dialogue) . . . 1933

248 A New Term 1935
248.1 学期 (xuéqī) . . . 1935
248.2 niánjí . . . 1936
248.3 校长 (xiàozhǎng) . . . 1937
248.4 校 (xiào) . . . 1938
248.5 高中 (gāozhōng) . . . 1940
248.6 高 (gāo) . . . 1941
248.7 家长 (jiāzhǎng) . . . 1942

249 Hitting the Books 1945
249.1 yùxí . . . 1945
249.2 fàngxué . . . 1946
249.3 读音 (dúyīn) . . . 1947
249.4 读 (dú) . . . 1948
249.5 chéngjì . . . 1950
249.6 nǔlì . . . 1950

250 Hobbies 1953
250.1 àihào . . . 1953
250.2 xìngqù . . . 1954
250.3 小说 (xiǎoshuō) . . . 1955
250.4 gùshi . . . 1956
250.5 xiàqí . . . 1957

251 Essays and New Characters **1959**
251.1 piān . . . 1959
251.2 作文 (zuòwén) . . . 1960
251.3 作 (zuò) . . . 1961
251.4 写作 (xiězuò) . . . 1963
251.5 写 (xiě) . . . 1964
251.6 生字 (shēngzì) . . . 1965
251.7 xiūgǎi . . . 1966

252 Happy and Sad **1969**
252.1 开心 (kāixīn) . . . 1969
252.2 gǎndào . . . 1970
252.3 shāngxīn . . . 1971
252.4 shīwàng . . . 1972
252.5 mǎnyì . . . 1973

253 Grandparents and Relatives **1975**
253.1 yéye . . . 1975
253.2 nǎinai . . . 1976
253.3 小孩 (xiǎohái) . . . 1977
253.4 孩 (hái) . . . 1978
253.5 子女 (zǐnǚ) . . . 1979
253.6 qīnqi . . . 1980
253.7 (dialogue) . . . 1981

254 Born and Married **1983**
254.1 出生 (chūshēng) . . . 1983
254.2 jiéhūn . . . 1984
254.3 bìyè . . . 1985
254.4 hūnlǐ . . . 1986
254.5 shēnghuó . . . 1987

255 A Part-Time Job **1989**
255.1 打工 (dǎgōng) . . . 1989
255.2 工 (gōng) . . . 1990
255.3 gōngzī . . . 1992
255.4 同事 (tóngshì) . . . 1992
255.5 jiābān . . . 1993
255.6 lǎobǎn . . . 1994

256 What Do You Think? 1997
256.1 rènwéi . . . 1997
256.2 kànfǎ . . . 1998
256.3 看来 (kànlai) . . . 1999
256.4 yěxǔ . . . 2000
256.5 不同 (bùtóng) . . . 2001

257 Music and Shows 2003
257.1 yuèqì . . . 2003
257.2 dǎgǔ . . . 2004
257.3 yǎnchū . . . 2005
257.4 gēshǒu . . . 2006
257.5 gǔzhǎng . . . 2007

258 Warm-Hearted 2009
258.1 yǒuhǎo . . . 2009
258.2 热心 (rèxīn) . . . 2010
258.3 热 (rè) . . . 2011
258.4 nàixīn . . . 2013
258.5 yōumò . . . 2014
258.6 xìnggé . . . 2015

259 What Do You Do? 2017
259.1 zhíyè . . . 2017
259.2 作家 (zuòjiā) . . . 2018
259.3 lǜshī . . . 2019
259.4 jìzhě . . . 2020
259.5 电工 (diàngōng) . . . 2021
259.6 (dialogue) . . . 2022

260 What I Can Do 2025
260.1 nénglì . . . 2025
260.2 本事 (běnshi) . . . 2026
260.3 高手 (gāoshǒu) . . . 2027
260.4 jìshù . . . 2028
260.5 jìnbù . . . 2029

261 Have You Ever? 2031
261.1 jīngyàn . . . 2031
261.2 céngjīng . . . 2032

261.3 liúxué 2033
261.4 国外 (guówài) 2034
261.5 tǐyàn 2035

262 Win or Lose **2037**
262.1 wǎngqiú 2037
262.2 pīngpāngqiú 2038
262.3 对手 (duìshǒu) 2039
262.4 dǎbài 2040
262.5 jiāyóu 2041

263 Time Off Work **2043**
263.1 jīnglǐ 2043
263.2 fùzé 2044
263.3 请假 (qǐngjià) 2045
263.4 假 (jià) 2046
263.5 病假 (bìngjià) 2048
263.6 年假 (niánjià) 2049

264 Sorry, I Can't **2051**
264.1 jùjué 2051
264.2 kěxī 2052
264.3 bàoqiàn 2053
264.4 kǒngpà 2054
264.5 qíshí 2055

265 Shy or Brave **2057**
265.1 hàixiū 2057
265.2 yǒnggǎn 2058
265.3 dàfang 2059
265.4 小气 (xiǎoqì) 2060
265.5 jǐnzhāng 2061
265.6 (dialogue) 2062

266 Grown-Ups and Children **2065**
266.1 大人 (dàren) 2065
266.2 bǎobao 2066
266.3 男孩 (nánhái) 2067
266.4 女孩 (nǚhái) 2068
266.5 中年 (zhōngnián) 2069

267 Actors and Jokes **2071**
267.1 yǎnyuán . . . 2071
267.2 jiémù . . . 2072
267.3 明星 (míngxīng) . . . 2073
267.4 笑话 (xiàohua) . . . 2074
267.5 笑 (xiào) . . . 2075
267.6 好笑 (hǎoxiào) . . . 2076

268 Exams **2079**
268.1 bàomíng . . . 2079
268.2 口试 (kǒushì) . . . 2080
268.3 jígé . . . 2081
268.4 dá'àn . . . 2082
268.5 jiěshì . . . 2083

269 When I Was Little **2085**
269.1 从小 (cóngxiǎo) . . . 2085
269.2 先 (xiān) . . . 2086
269.3 先 (xiān) . . . 2087
269.4 tóngnián . . . 2088
269.5 本来 (běnlái) . . . 2089
269.6 wánjù . . . 2090

270 Do You Agree? **2093**
270.1 tóngyì . . . 2093
270.2 fǎnduì . . . 2094
270.3 zànchéng . . . 2095
270.4 zhīchí . . . 2096
270.5 xiāngxìn . . . 2097

271 Moods **2099**
271.1 jīdòng . . . 2099
271.2 gǎndòng . . . 2100
271.3 chījīng . . . 2101
271.4 wúliáo . . . 2102
271.5 心事 (xīnshì) . . . 2103
271.6 (dialogue) . . . 2104

272 Husband and Wife **2107**
272.1 qīzi 2107
272.2 老公 (lǎogōng) 2108
272.3 老 (lǎo) 2109
272.4 外公 (wàigōng) 2111
272.5 shūshu 2111
272.6 āyí 2112

273 Honest and Careful **2115**
273.1 chéngshí 2115
273.2 好客 (hàokè) 2116
273.3 用心 (yòngxīn) 2117
273.4 cūxīn 2118
273.5 xìxīn 2119

274 Free Time **2121**
274.1 huábīng 2121
274.2 shōují 2122
274.3 热门 (rèmén) 2123
274.4 手工 (shǒugōng) 2124
274.5 qiúmí 2125

275 Saying Sorry **2127**
275.1 dàoqiàn 2127
275.2 yuánliàng 2128
275.3 dāying 2129
275.4 jiēshòu 2130
275.5 suíbiàn 2131

276 A New Job **2133**
276.1 面试 (miànshì) 2133
276.2 cízhí 2134
276.3 机会 (jīhuì) 2135
276.4 tuìxiū 2136
276.5 大事 (dàshì) 2137

277 Likes and Dislikes **2139**
277.1 yǒuqù 2139
277.2 tǎoyàn 2140
277.3 xīnshǎng 2141

277.4 xiǎngshòu 2142
277.5 rè'ài 2143
277.6 (dialogue) 2144
277.7 (dialogue) 2145

278 First, Then, Last 2147
278.1 最后 (zuìhòu) 2147
278.2 最 (zuì) 2148
278.3 先…然后…最后 (xiān … ránhòu … zuìhòu) 2150
278.4 然 (rán) 2151
278.5 shǒuxiān 2152
278.6 jiēzhe 2154
278.7 吃了饭以后 (chī le fàn yǐhòu) 2155
278.8 Practice 2156

279 The Next Day 2159
279.1 第二天 (dì'èr tiān) 2159
279.2 第 (dì) 2161
279.3 …的时候 (… de shíhou) 2162
279.4 突然 (tūrán) 2163
279.5 突 (tū) 2164
279.6 一下子 (yíxiàzi) 2166
279.7 (reading) 2167
279.8 Practice 2169

280 What I Think 2173
280.1 意见 (yìjiàn) 2173
280.2 意 (yì) 2174
280.3 我觉得… (wǒ juéde …) 2176
280.4 hǎoxiàng 2177
280.5 这么 (zhème) 2178
280.6 Practice 2179

281 For Example 2183
281.1 比如 (bǐrú) 2183
281.2 如 (rú) 2184
281.3 因为…所以… (yīnwèi … suǒyǐ …) 2186
281.4 所 (suǒ) 2187
281.5 yīncǐ 2188
281.6 lìzi 2189

281.7 (one reason) 2190
281.8 Practice 2191

282 You Should Rest **2195**
282.1 该 (gāi) 2195
282.2 该 (gāi) 2196
282.3 应该 (yīnggāi) 2198
282.4 应 (yīng) 2199
282.5 你应该… (nǐ yīnggāi …) 2200
282.6 最好 (zuìhǎo) 2201
282.7 děi 2202
282.8 Practice 2204

283 Which Way? **2207**
283.1 怎么 (zěnme) 2207
283.2 怎 (zěn) 2208
283.3 去…怎么走 (qù … zěnme zǒu) 2210
283.4 走 (zǒu) 2211
283.5 wǎng 2212
283.6 再 (zài) 2213
283.7 路过 (lùguò) 2215
283.8 Practice 2216

284 Two Tickets **2219**
284.1 zhàntái 2219
284.2 坐火车去 (zuò huǒchē qù) 2220
284.3 坐 (zuò) 2221
284.4 dānchéng 2223
284.5 zuòwèi 2224
284.6 tuìpiào 2225
284.7 坐在这儿 (zuò zài zhèr) 2226
284.8 一家书店 (yì jiā shūdiàn) 2227
284.9 Practice 2228

285 Lost on the Way **2231**
285.1 找回 (zhǎohuí) 2231
285.2 我的手机不见了 (wǒ de shǒujī bú jiàn le) 2232
285.3 zhèngjiàn 2233
285.4 guàshī 2234
285.5 liánxì 2236

285.6 找不到 (zhǎo bu dào) . . . 2237
285.7 (a note) . . . 2238
285.8 Practice . . . 2239

286 How It Felt **2243**
286.1 感觉 (gǎnjué) . . . 2243
286.2 感 (gǎn) . . . 2244
286.3 我感觉… (wǒ gǎnjué …) . . . 2246
286.4 学了两年 (xué le liǎng nián) . . . 2247
286.5 duōjiǔ . . . 2248
286.6 yíhàn . . . 2249
286.7 Practice . . . 2250

287 What I Want to Be **2253**
287.1 当 (dāng) . . . 2253
287.2 当 (dāng) . . . 2254
287.3 以后我想… (yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng …) . . . 2255
287.4 mèngxiǎng . . . 2256
287.5 mùbiāo . . . 2258
287.6 我最喜欢… (wǒ zuì xǐhuan …) . . . 2259
287.7 Practice . . . 2260

288 If It Rains **2263**
288.1 就 (jiù) . . . 2263
288.2 就 (jiù) . . . 2264
288.3 要是 (yàoshi) . . . 2266
288.4 要是…就… (yàoshi … jiù …) . . . 2267
288.5 的话 (dehuà) . . . 2268
288.6 看天气 (kàn tiānqì) . . . 2269
288.7 Practice . . . 2270

289 If I Had the Time **2273**
289.1 如果 (rúguǒ) . . . 2273
289.2 果 (guǒ) . . . 2274
289.3 如果…就… (rúguǒ … jiù …) . . . 2276
289.4 如果…就会… (rúguǒ … jiù huì …) . . . 2277
289.5 不然 (bùrán) . . . 2278
289.6 (six lines) . . . 2279
289.7 (dialogue) . . . 2281

290 In the News **2285**
290.1 xīnwén . . . 2285
290.2 bàodào . . . 2286
290.3 diàntái . . . 2287
290.4 zhǔchírén . . . 2288
290.5 热点 (rèdiǎn) . . . 2289

291 Something New **2291**
291.1 cǎifǎng . . . 2291
291.2 发明 (fāmíng) . . . 2292
291.3 发 (fā) . . . 2293
291.4 shìjiàn . . . 2295
291.5 突发 (tūfā) . . . 2296
291.6 xuānbù . . . 2297

292 On the Radio **2299**
292.1 guǎngbō . . . 2299
292.2 guānzhòng . . . 2300
292.3 zhíbō . . . 2301
292.4 tīngzhòng . . . 2302
292.5 fābiǎo . . . 2303

293 Headlines **2305**
293.1 zázhì . . . 2305
293.2 报 (bào) . . . 2306
293.3 报 (bào) . . . 2307
293.4 见报 (jiànbào) . . . 2309
293.5 tóutiáo . . . 2310
293.6 guānzhù . . . 2311

294 How It Turned Out **2313**
294.1 qíngkuàng . . . 2313
294.2 yǐnqǐ . . . 2314
294.3 yǐngxiǎng . . . 2315
294.4 zhōngyú . . . 2316
294.5 yúshì . . . 2317

295 Starting Over **2319**
295.1 zuìchū . . . 2319
295.2 重新 (chóngxīn) . . . 2320

295.3 新 (xīn) 2321
295.4 当天 (dàngtiān) 2323
295.5 事后 (shìhòu) 2324
295.6 dāngchǎng 2325
295.7 (dialogue) 2326

296 A Crash **2329**
296.1 意外 (yìwài) 2329
296.2 chēhuò 2330
296.3 shāchē 2331
296.4 新手 (xīnshǒu) 2332
296.5 péiqián 2333

297 Whose Fault **2335**
297.1 bǎoxiǎn 2335
297.2 事故 (shìgù) 2336
297.3 故 (gù) 2337
297.4 zérèn 2339
297.5 后果 (hòuguǒ) 2340
297.6 chǔlǐ 2341

298 A Fire **2343**
298.1 huǒzāi 2343
298.2 救火 (jiùhuǒ) 2344
298.3 救 (jiù) 2345
298.4 xiāofángyuán 2347
298.5 hǎn 2348
298.6 jiùmìng 2349

299 Help Arrives **2351**
299.1 得救 (déjiù) 2351
299.2 jíshí 2352
299.3 jíjiù 2353
299.4 yūndǎo 2354
299.5 qiǎngjiù 2355

300 Life and Death **2357**
300.1 dìzhèn 2357
300.2 死 (sǐ) 2358
300.3 死 (sǐ) 2359

300.4 shēngmìng 2360
300.5 死因 (sǐyīn) 2361
300.6 bàozhà 2362

301 Getting Out **2365**
301.1 táo 2365
301.2 huāng 2366
301.3 fú 2367
301.4 gǔzhé 2368
301.5 果然 (guǒrán) 2369
301.6 (dialogue) 2370

302 A Baby on the Way **2373**
302.1 huáiyùn 2373
302.2 活 (huó) 2374
302.3 活 (huó) 2375
302.4 yīng'ér 2377
302.5 救活 (jiùhuó) 2378
302.6 shuāngbāotāi 2378

303 A Name and a School **2381**
303.1 起名 (qǐmíng) 2381
303.2 小名 (xiǎomíng) 2382
303.3 yòu'éryuán 2383
303.4 开学 (kāixué) 2384
303.5 新生 (xīnshēng) 2385

304 Starting School **2387**
304.1 rùxué 2387
304.2 日记 (rìjì) 2388
304.3 记 (jì) 2389
304.4 报到 (bàodào) 2390
304.5 xuéfèi 2391
304.6 jìzhù 2392

305 Getting Engaged **2395**
305.1 tán liàn'ài 2395
305.2 qiúhūn 2396
305.3 dìnghūn 2397
305.4 喜事 (xǐshì) 2398

305.5 xīnláng 2399

306 The Wedding 2401
306.1 xīnniáng 2401
306.2 经过 (jīngguò) 2402
306.3 经 (jīng) 2403
306.4 新人 (xīnrén) 2405
306.5 jǔxíng 2406
306.6 xǐtáng 2407

307 Marrying and Parting 2409
307.1 fēnshǒu 2409
307.2 líhūn 2410
307.3 zàihūn 2411
307.4 mìyuè 2412
307.5 hūnshā 2413
307.6 (dialogue) 2414

308 Ever Since 2417
308.1 shīzōng 2417
308.2 自从 (zìcóng) 2418
308.3 自 (zì) 2419
308.4 来自 (láizì) 2420
308.5 fànzuì 2421
308.6 pàichūsuǒ 2422

309 A Thief 2425
309.1 qiǎngjié 2425
309.2 小偷 (xiǎotōu) 2426
309.3 偷 (tōu) 2427
309.4 piàn 2429
309.5 piànzi 2430
309.6 故意 (gùyì) 2430

310 Who Did It 2433
310.1 huáiyí 2433
310.2 zhèngrén 2434
310.3 zhèngjù 2435
310.4 shuōhuǎng 2436
310.5 chéngrèn 2437

311 The Police Car **2439**
311.1 diàochá 2439
311.2 警车 (jǐngchē) 2440
311.3 警 (jǐng) 2441
311.4 zhuī 2443
311.5 警报 (jǐngbào) 2444
311.6 jiāojǐng 2445

312 Locked Up **2447**
312.1 jiānyù 2447
312.2 fákuǎn 2448
312.3 dǎjià 2449
312.4 活该 (huógāi) 2450
312.5 死活 (sǐhuó) 2451
312.6 (dialogue) 2452

313 Moving House **2455**
313.1 zhuāngxiū 2455
313.2 才 (cái) 2456
313.3 才 (cái) 2457
313.4 dìngjū 2459
313.5 shěbude 2460
313.6 shìyìng 2461

314 Saying Goodbye **2463**
314.1 zànglǐ 2463
314.2 生前 (shēngqián) 2464
314.3 ānwèi 2465
314.4 mùdì 2466
314.5 liúlèi 2467

315 Once Again **2469**
315.1 jiànjiàn 2469
315.2 又 (yòu) 2470
315.3 又 (yòu) 2471
315.4 自在 (zìzai) 2473
315.5 jìngrán 2474
315.6 réngrán 2475

316 A New Place **2477**
316.1 dēngjì 2477
316.2 shúxī 2478
316.3 当地 (dāngdì) 2479
316.4 人生 (rénshēng) 2480
316.5 自然 (zìrán) 2481

317 Looking Back **2483**
317.1 qīngnián 2483
317.2 chéngnián 2484
317.3 hūnyīn 2485
317.4 jiātíng 2486
317.5 事先 (shìxiān) 2487
317.6 (dialogue) 2488
317.7 (dialogue) 2489

318 Letters from Far Away **2491**
318.1 bǐyǒu 2491
318.2 xìnfēng 2492
318.3 míngxìnpiàn 2493
318.4 回音 (huíyīn) 2494
318.5 zhuǎngào 2495

319 Calls and Confidence **2497**
319.1 回电 (huídiàn) 2497
319.2 信心 (xìnxīn) 2498
319.3 信 (xìn) 2499
319.4 来电 (láidiàn) 2501
319.5 tōngxìn 2502
319.6 huàfèi 2503

320 On the Phone **2505**
320.1 guàduàn 2505
320.2 bōdǎ 2506
320.3 dǎtōng 2507
320.4 说起 (shuōqǐ) 2508
320.5 语音 (yǔyīn) 2509

321 People of Long Ago **2511**
321.1 lìshǐ 2511
321.2 古人 (gǔrén) 2512
321.3 古 (gǔ) 2513
321.4 古书 (gǔshū) 2514
321.5 古老 (gǔlǎo) 2515
321.6 文字 (wénzì) 2516

322 Back Then **2519**
322.1 当年 (dāngnián) 2519
322.2 早年 (zǎonián) 2520
322.3 晚年 (wǎnnián) 2521
322.4 一生 (yìshēng) 2522
322.5 huáiniàn 2523

323 Decades and Eras **2525**
323.1 少年 (shàonián) 2525
323.2 时期 (shíqī) 2526
323.3 年代 (niándài) 2527
323.4 代 (dài) 2528
323.5 古代 (gǔdài) 2529
323.6 现代 (xiàndài) 2530
323.7 (dialogue) 2531

324 Remembering **2533**
324.1 想起 (xiǎngqǐ) 2533
324.2 jìniàn 2534
324.3 liúxià 2535
324.4 时代 (shídài) 2536
324.5 yìnxiàng 2537

325 Gone but Remembered **2539**
325.1 jiǎngshù 2539
325.2 去世 (qùshì) 2540
325.3 世 (shì) 2541
325.4 后代 (hòudài) 2543
325.5 世代 (shìdài) 2544
325.6 xiǎngniàn 2544

326 Around the World **2547**
326.1 国家 (guójiā) 2547
326.2 世界 (shìjiè) 2548
326.3 界 (jiè) 2549
326.4 外界 (wàijiè) 2551
326.5 jiànlì 2551
326.6 文明 (wénmíng) 2552

327 Heroes and Emperors **2555**
327.1 名人 (míngrén) 2555
327.2 yīngxióng 2556
327.3 huángdì 2557
327.4 dǎzhàng 2558
327.5 zhànzhēng 2559

328 A Legend **2561**
328.1 shénhuà 2561
328.2 传说 (chuánshuō) 2562
328.3 传 (chuán) 2563
328.4 liúchuán 2564
328.5 lóng 2565
328.6 传话 (chuánhuà) 2566

329 Once upon a Time **2569**
329.1 tónghuà 2569
329.2 gōngzhǔ 2570
329.3 xiānnǚ 2571
329.4 xiāoshī 2572
329.5 jiéjú 2573
329.6 (dialogue) 2574

330 The King's Son **2577**
330.1 jìchéng 2577
330.2 王子 (wángzǐ) 2578
330.3 王 (wáng) 2579
330.4 国王 (guówáng) 2580
330.5 王后 (wánghòu) 2581
330.6 王国 (wángguó) 2582

331 Monsters and Treasure **2585**
331.1 yāoguài 2585
331.2 shénxiān 2586
331.3 mófǎ 2587
331.4 bǎowù 2588
331.5 cáng 2589

332 Ghost Stories **2591**
332.1 dǎnzi 2591
332.2 鬼 (guǐ) 2592
332.3 鬼 (guǐ) 2593
332.4 nàoguǐ 2595
332.5 见鬼 (jiànguǐ) 2596
332.6 人间 (rénjiān) 2597

333 New Year's Eve **2599**
333.1 春晚 (Chūnwǎn) 2599
333.2 Chúxī 2600
333.3 niányèfàn 2601
333.4 shǒusuì 2602
333.5 bàinián 2603

334 Red Envelopes **2605**
334.1 正月 (zhēngyuè) 2605
334.2 红包 (hóngbāo) 2606
334.3 红 (hóng) 2607
334.4 tiē 2608
334.5 chūnlián 2609
334.6 红火 (hónghuǒ) 2610

335 Lanterns and Riddles **2613**
335.1 Yuánxiāo 2613
335.2 dēnglóng 2614
335.3 cāi 2615
335.4 míyǔ 2616
335.5 biānpào 2617
335.6 (dialogue) 2618

336 Seeing Friends Off **2621**
336.1 gàobié 2621
336.2 欢送 (huānsòng) 2622
336.3 送 (sòng) 2623
336.4 送客 (sòngkè) 2625
336.5 sònglǐ 2625
336.6 wòshǒu 2626

337 Best Wishes **2629**
337.1 gōngxǐ 2629
337.2 祝 (zhù) 2630
337.3 祝 (zhù) 2631
337.4 心意 (xīnyì) 2633
337.5 hǎoyùn 2634
337.6 xǔyuàn 2635

338 Festival Visits **2637**
338.1 过节 (guòjié) 2637
338.2 bàifǎng 2638
338.3 tuányuán 2639
338.4 假日 (jiàrì) 2640
338.5 fēngsú 2641

339 National Day **2643**
339.1 长假 (chángjià) 2643
339.2 国庆 (Guóqìng) 2644
339.3 庆 (qìng) 2645
339.4 庆祝 (qìngzhù) 2646
339.5 喜庆 (xǐqìng) 2647
339.6 yānhuā 2648

340 Old Ways **2651**
340.1 chuántǒng 2651
340.2 jiǎngjiu 2652
340.3 guījù 2653
340.4 节气 (jiéqì) 2654
340.5 sǎomù 2655
340.6 (dialogue) 2656

341 Mooncakes **2659**
341.1 dòushā 2659
341.2 月饼 (yuèbǐng) 2660
341.3 饼 (bǐng) 2661
341.4 xiànr 2663
341.5 pǐncháng 2664
341.6 生意 (shēngyi) 2665

342 Mid-Autumn **2667**
342.1 shǎngyuè 2667
342.2 中秋 (Zhōngqiū) 2668
342.3 秋 (qiū) 2669
342.4 期间 (qījiān) 2671
342.5 guìhuā 2672
342.6 jiāxiāng 2673

343 Far from Home **2675**
343.1 yuèguāng 2675
343.2 多年 (duōnián) 2676
343.3 心中 (xīnzhōng) 2677
343.4 zhùfú 2678
343.5 fēnxiǎng 2679

344 Keeping Memories **2681**
344.1 bǎocún 2681
344.2 jìyì 2682
344.3 wǎngshì 2683
344.4 xiàngcè 2684
344.5 yǒngyuǎn 2685

345 Looking Back **2687**
345.1 jùshuō 2687
345.2 cóngcǐ 2688
345.3 qǐyuán 2689
345.4 wǎngyǒu 2690
345.5 yóubiān 2691
345.6 (dialogue) 2692
345.7 (dialogue) 2693

346 Thinking It Over **2695**
346.1 kǎolǜ . . . 2695
346.2 guāndiǎn . . . 2696
346.3 感想 (gǎnxiǎng) . . . 2697
346.4 以为 (yǐwéi) . . . 2698
346.5 gūjì . . . 2699

347 What Do You Mean? **2701**
347.1 zhǔyi . . . 2701
347.2 意思 (yìsi) . . . 2702
347.3 思 (sī) . . . 2703
347.4 sīkǎo . . . 2705
347.5 yìyì . . . 2706
347.6 体会 (tǐhuì) . . . 2707

348 Talking It Over **2709**
348.1 tǎolùn . . . 2709
348.2 shāngliang . . . 2710
348.3 zhēnglùn . . . 2711
348.4 duìfāng . . . 2712
348.5 yízhì . . . 2713

349 Ways of Seeing **2715**
349.1 kàndài . . . 2715
349.2 想法 (xiǎngfǎ) . . . 2716
349.3 法 (fǎ) . . . 2717
349.4 说法 (shuōfa) . . . 2719
349.5 做法 (zuòfǎ) . . . 2720
349.6 zhǔzhāng . . . 2721

350 Facts and Grounds **2723**
350.1 shìshí . . . 2723
350.2 zhèngmíng . . . 2724
350.3 gēnjù . . . 2725
350.4 pànduàn . . . 2726
350.5 quèshí . . . 2727

351 That Makes Sense **2729**
351.1 fēnxī . . . 2729
351.2 有理 (yǒulǐ) . . . 2730

351.3 理 (lǐ) 2731
351.4 jiǎnglǐ 2733
351.5 理想 (lǐxiǎng) 2734
351.6 心理 (xīnlǐ) 2735
351.7 (dialogue) 2736

352 Same Here **2739**
352.1 同感 (tónggǎn) 2739
352.2 kěndìng 2740
352.3 rènkě 2741
352.4 本意 (běnyì) 2742
352.5 biǎoshì 2743

353 You've Got a Point **2745**
353.1 shuōfú 2745
353.2 道理 (dàoli) 2746
353.3 道 (dào) 2747
353.4 不见得 (bújiànde) 2749
353.5 fǎnbó 2750
353.6 rèntóng 2751

354 Changing the Subject **2753**
354.1 tíwèn 2753
354.2 话题 (huàtí) 2754
354.3 题 (tí) 2755
354.4 tímù 2757
354.5 nèiróng 2758
354.6 tánhuà 2759

355 Thanks, but No **2761**
355.1 xièjué 2761
355.2 好意 (hǎoyì) 2762
355.3 kěn 2763
355.4 fǒurèn 2764
355.5 当面 (dāngmiàn) 2765

356 A Missed Chance **2767**
356.1 jiàoxun 2767
356.2 错过 (cuòguò) 2768
356.3 错 (cuò) 2769

356.4 出错 (chūcuò) 2771
356.5 cuòwù 2772
356.6 gǎizhèng 2773

357 Owning Up **2775**
357.1 rèncuò 2775
357.2 气话 (qìhuà) 2776
357.3 口气 (kǒuqì) 2777
357.4 pīpíng 2778
357.5 biǎoyáng 2779
357.6 (dialogue) 2780

358 Real Manners **2783**
358.1 lǐmào 2783
358.2 真正 (zhēnzhèng) 2784
358.3 真 (zhēn) 2785
358.4 真心 (zhēnxīn) 2787
358.5 qiānxū 2788
358.6 面子 (miànzi) 2789

359 Rules **2791**
359.1 guīzé 2791
359.2 zūnshǒu 2792
359.3 wéifǎn 2793
359.4 xiànzhì 2794
359.5 dàodé 2795

360 No Need **2797**
360.1 gōnggòng 2797
360.2 必要 (bìyào) 2798
360.3 必 (bì) 2799
360.4 不必 (búbì) 2801
360.5 chǎnghé 2802
360.6 chāduì 2803

361 A Good Guest, a Good Host **2805**
361.1 dǎ zhāohu 2805
361.2 zhāodài 2806
361.3 jūgōng 2807
361.4 jìngjiǔ 2808

361.5 看不起 (kànbuqǐ) 2809

362 What You Have to Do 2811
362.1 dàshēng 2811
362.2 必须 (bìxū) 2812
362.3 须 (xū) 2813
362.4 luàn 2815
362.5 公正 (gōngzhèng) 2815
362.6 yìwù 2816

363 Out in Public 2819
363.1 zūnzhòng 2819
363.2 xiǎoshēng 2820
363.3 fǎlǜ 2821
363.4 fànfǎ 2822
363.5 sùzhì 2823
363.6 (dialogue) 2824

364 Not Allowed 2827
364.1 quàn 2827
364.2 不准 (bùzhǔn) 2828
364.3 准 (zhǔn) 2829
364.4 biāozhǔn 2831
364.5 pīzhǔn 2832
364.6 tíxǐng 2833

365 Yes, but 2835
365.1 jiànyì 2835
365.2 可是 (kěshì) 2836
365.3 可 (kě) 2837
365.4 可见 (kějiàn) 2838
365.5 不如 (bùrú) 2839
365.6 zhōnggào 2840

366 Take My Advice 2843
366.1 bìmiǎn 2843
366.2 当心 (dāngxīn) 2844
366.3 jiānchí 2845
366.4 fàngqì 2846
366.5 zhíde 2847

367 I See What You Mean **2849**
367.1 wùhuì . . . 2849
367.2 了解 (liǎojiě) . . . 2850
367.3 解 (jiě) . . . 2851
367.4 理解 (lǐjiě) . . . 2853
367.5 见解 (jiànjiě) . . . 2854
367.6 可笑 (kěxiào) . . . 2855

368 Keep Going **2857**
368.1 zhìshǎo . . . 2857
368.2 máobìng . . . 2858
368.3 了不起 (liǎobuqǐ) . . . 2859
368.4 gǔlì . . . 2860
368.5 xuǎnzé . . . 2861
368.6 (dialogue) . . . 2862

369 Making It Clear **2865**
369.1 说明 (shuōmíng) . . . 2865
369.2 但是 (dànshì) . . . 2866
369.3 但 (dàn) . . . 2867
369.4 jǔlì . . . 2869
369.5 qícì . . . 2869
369.6 lìngwài . . . 2870

370 The Key Point **2873**
370.1 yīnsù . . . 2873
370.2 bìjìng . . . 2874
370.3 guānjiàn . . . 2875
370.4 作用 (zuòyòng) . . . 2876
370.5 zǒngzhī . . . 2877

371 Although **2879**
371.1 shènzhì . . . 2879
371.2 虽然 (suīrán) . . . 2880
371.3 虽 (suī) . . . 2881
371.4 jiélùn . . . 2883
371.5 zǒngjié . . . 2883
371.6 yuánzé . . . 2884

372 Anyway **2887**
372.1 fǎnzhèng . . . 2887
372.2 dàodǐ . . . 2888
372.3 同时 (tóngshí) . . . 2889
372.4 用意 (yòngyì) . . . 2890
372.5 yōudiǎn . . . 2891

373 Pros and Cons **2893**
373.1 quēdiǎn . . . 2893
373.2 hǎochu . . . 2894
373.3 huàichu . . . 2895
373.4 天真 (tiānzhēn) . . . 2896
373.5 当真 (dàngzhēn) . . . 2897
373.6 (dialogue) . . . 2898
373.7 (dialogue) . . . 2899

374 People and Government **2901**
374.1 人口 (rénkǒu) . . . 2901
374.2 zhèngfǔ . . . 2902
374.3 wénhuà . . . 2903
374.4 mínzú . . . 2904
374.5 fāzhǎn . . . 2905

375 Helping Others **2907**
375.1 qióng . . . 2907
375.2 社会 (shèhuì) . . . 2908
375.3 社 (shè) . . . 2909
375.4 juān . . . 2911
375.5 zhìyuànzhě . . . 2911
375.6 hùxiāng . . . 2912

376 Out in Public **2915**
376.1 huódòng . . . 2915
376.2 社工 (shègōng) . . . 2916
376.3 àihù . . . 2917
376.4 ràngzuò . . . 2918
376.5 guǎngchǎngwǔ . . . 2919

377 Our Neighbourhood **2921**
377.1 jūmín . . . 2921
377.2 社区 (shèqū) . . . 2922
377.3 区 (qū) . . . 2923
377.4 小区 (xiǎoqū) . . . 2925
377.5 zhōuwéi . . . 2926
377.6 学区房 (xuéqūfáng) . . . 2927

378 Noise Next Door **2929**
378.1 zàoyīn . . . 2929
378.2 bàoyuàn . . . 2930
378.3 géyīn . . . 2931
378.4 生人 (shēngrén) . . . 2932
378.5 wùyè . . . 2933

379 Feeling Safe **2935**
379.1 lóudào . . . 2935
379.2 安心 (ānxīn) . . . 2936
379.3 安 (ān) . . . 2937
379.4 不安 (bù'ān) . . . 2938
379.5 ménjìn . . . 2939
379.6 zhì'ān . . . 2940
379.7 (dialogue) . . . 2941

380 Clean Air **2943**
380.1 huánjìng . . . 2943
380.2 kōngqì . . . 2944
380.3 wūrǎn . . . 2945
380.4 dìqiú . . . 2946
380.5 huánbǎo . . . 2947

381 The Whole Family **2949**
381.1 fēnlèi . . . 2949
381.2 全家 (quánjiā) . . . 2950
381.3 全 (quán) . . . 2951
381.4 huíshōu . . . 2952
381.5 全国 (quánguó) . . . 2953
381.6 安全感 (ānquángǎn) . . . 2954

382 The Security Guard **2957**
382.1 zhíbān 2957
382.2 保安 (bǎo'ān) 2958
382.3 保 (bǎo) 2959
382.4 jiānkòng 2961
382.5 bǎozhèng 2962
382.6 xúnluó 2963

383 Saving Energy **2965**
383.1 diànfèi 2965
383.2 làngfèi 2966
383.3 néngyuán 2967
383.4 jiǎnshǎo 2968
383.5 yícìxìng 2969

384 Becoming Green **2971**
384.1 zhòngshù 2971
384.2 成为 (chéngwéi) 2972
384.3 成 (chéng) 2973
384.4 成本 (chéngběn) 2975
384.5 zīyuán 2975
384.6 zēngjiā 2976

385 Good Reasons **2979**
385.1 tígāo 2979
385.2 八成 (bāchéng) 2980
385.3 节能 (jiénéng) 2981
385.4 zhòngshì 2982
385.5 fāngshì 2983
385.6 (dialogue) 2984

386 Second-Hand **2987**
386.1 二手 (èrshǒu) 2987
386.2 变成 (biànchéng) 2988
386.3 变 (biàn) 2989
386.4 xiánzhì 2991
386.5 huásuàn 2991
386.6 变天 (biàntiān) 2992

387 Money In, Money Out **2995**
387.1 shōurù . . . 2995
387.2 cúnkuǎn . . . 2996
387.3 zhàngdān . . . 2997
387.4 wǎnggòu . . . 2998
387.5 yùsuàn . . . 2999

388 Making a Date **3001**
388.1 chōukòng . . . 3001
388.2 约会 (yuēhuì) . . . 3002
388.3 约 (yuē) . . . 3003
388.4 shīyuē . . . 3004
388.5 tíqián . . . 3005
388.6 时区 (shíqū) . . . 3006

389 In Case **3009**
389.1 bèiyòng . . . 3009
389.2 节约 (jiéyuē) . . . 3010
389.3 fēngxiǎn . . . 3011
389.4 yǐfáng . . . 3012
389.5 到期 (dàoqī) . . . 3013

390 As We Agreed **3015**
390.1 quèdìng . . . 3015
390.2 约定 (yuēdìng) . . . 3016
390.3 定 (dìng) . . . 3017
390.4 定期 (dìngqī) . . . 3019
390.5 如期 (rúqī) . . . 3020
390.6 大约 (dàyuē) . . . 3021

391 When Plans Change **3023**
391.1 rìchéng . . . 3023
391.2 línshí . . . 3024
391.3 láidejí . . . 3025
391.4 gǎnshàng . . . 3026
391.5 到时候 (dào shíhou) . . . 3027
391.6 (dialogue) . . . 3028

392 A Change of Plan **3031**
392.1 改 (gǎi) . . . 3031
392.2 改 (gǎi) . . . 3032
392.3 改期 (gǎiqī) . . . 3034
392.4 改变 (gǎibiàn) . . . 3035
392.5 改名 (gǎimíng) . . . 3036
392.6 改口 (gǎikǒu) . . . 3037

393 Be Sure To **3039**
393.1 zhǔfu . . . 3039
393.2 千万 (qiānwàn) . . . 3040
393.3 万 (wàn) . . . 3041
393.4 万能 (wànnéng) . . . 3043
393.5 suíshí . . . 3044
393.6 shùnlì . . . 3045

394 Success or Failure **3047**
394.1 chénggōng . . . 3047
394.2 shībài . . . 3048
394.3 màoxiǎn . . . 3049
394.4 báifèi . . . 3050
394.5 不变 (búbiàn) . . . 3051

395 Getting Results **3053**
395.1 shíxiàn . . . 3053
395.2 取得 (qǔdé) . . . 3054
395.3 取 (qǔ) . . . 3055
395.4 成果 (chéngguǒ) . . . 3057
395.5 wánchéng . . . 3058
395.6 tiáojiàn . . . 3059

396 Whatever Happens **3061**
396.1 bùguǎn . . . 3061
396.2 jìrán . . . 3062
396.3 chúfēi . . . 3063
396.4 全天 (quántiān) . . . 3064
396.5 jíshǐ . . . 3065
396.6 (dialogue) . . . 3066

397 Surely Not **3069**
397.1 fàng gēzi . . . 3069
397.2 难道 (nándào) . . . 3070
397.3 难 (nán) . . . 3071
397.4 难得 (nándé) . . . 3073
397.5 为难 (wéinán) . . . 3073
397.6 jièkǒu . . . 3074

398 It Depends **3077**
398.1 tàidu . . . 3077
398.2 qūbié . . . 3078
398.3 地区 (dìqū) . . . 3079
398.4 现成 (xiànchéng) . . . 3080
398.5 qǔjuéyú . . . 3081

399 Only If **3083**
399.1 yāoqiú . . . 3083
399.2 只有 (zhǐyǒu) . . . 3084
399.3 只 (zhǐ) . . . 3085
399.4 只要 (zhǐyào) . . . 3086
399.5 mǎnzú . . . 3087
399.6 成家 (chéngjiā) . . . 3088

400 Moving the Dates **3091**
400.1 tiáozhěng . . . 3091
400.2 yáncháng . . . 3092
400.3 suōduǎn . . . 3093
400.4 yuándìng . . . 3094
400.5 安定 (āndìng) . . . 3095

401 Plans for the Future **3097**
401.1 qiántú . . . 3097
401.2 gǎiháng . . . 3098
401.3 成长 (chéngzhǎng) . . . 3099
401.4 变老 (biànlǎo) . . . 3100
401.5 yíqiè . . . 3101
401.6 (dialogue) . . . 3102
401.7 (dialogue) . . . 3103

402 At the Station **3105**
402.1 chéngkè . . . 3105
402.2 候车 (hòuchē) . . . 3106
402.3 gāotiě . . . 3107
402.4 huànchéng . . . 3108
402.5 chēxiāng . . . 3109

403 Travellers **3111**
403.1 hòuchēshì . . . 3111
403.2 旅客 (lǚkè) . . . 3112
403.3 旅 (lǚ) . . . 3113
403.4 正点 (zhèngdiǎn) . . . 3115
403.5 lièchēyuán . . . 3116
403.6 站长 (zhànzhǎng) . . . 3117

404 Tickets, Please **3119**
404.1 shòupiàochù . . . 3119
404.2 检票 (jiǎnpiào) . . . 3120
404.3 检 (jiǎn) . . . 3121
404.4 bǔpiào . . . 3123
404.5 wòpù . . . 3124
404.6 yìngzuò . . . 3124

405 Through the Gates **3127**
405.1 zhídá . . . 3127
405.2 进入 (jìnrù) . . . 3128
405.3 入 (rù) . . . 3129
405.4 出入 (chūrù) . . . 3131
405.5 mòbānchē . . . 3132
405.6 tíngkào . . . 3133

406 A Busy Platform **3135**
406.1 yōngjǐ . . . 3135
406.2 来回 (láihuí) . . . 3136
406.3 gǎiqiān . . . 3137
406.4 qìchē . . . 3138
406.5 xínglijià . . . 3139

407 Pulling In **3141**
407.1 进站 (jìnzhàn) . . . 3141
407.2 ruǎnwò . . . 3142
407.3 kòngwèi . . . 3143
407.4 zhōngdiǎnzhàn . . . 3144
407.5 dòngchē . . . 3145
407.6 (dialogue) . . . 3146

408 By Bus **3149**
408.1 zhànpái . . . 3149
408.2 公交 (gōngjiāo) . . . 3150
408.3 交 (jiāo) . . . 3151
408.4 tóubì . . . 3152
408.5 客车 (kèchē) . . . 3153
408.6 起点 (qǐdiǎn) . . . 3154

409 Heavy Traffic **3157**
409.1 gāofēng . . . 3157
409.2 交通 (jiāotōng) . . . 3158
409.3 通 (tōng) . . . 3159
409.4 通车 (tōngchē) . . . 3161
409.5 shòupiàoyuán . . . 3162
409.6 打车 (dǎchē) . . . 3163

410 Long Trips **3165**
410.1 chángtú . . . 3165
410.2 chēfèi . . . 3166
410.3 通过 (tōngguò) . . . 3167
410.4 开通 (kāitōng) . . . 3168
410.5 上路 (shànglù) . . . 3169

411 On the Water **3171**
411.1 mǎtou . . . 3171
411.2 船长 (chuánzhǎng) . . . 3172
411.3 船 (chuán) . . . 3173
411.4 开船 (kāichuán) . . . 3175
411.5 dùchuán . . . 3176
411.6 救生衣 (jiùshēngyī) . . . 3176

412 Harbour and Deck **3179**
412.1 gǎngkǒu 3179
412.2 jiǎbǎn 3180
412.3 chuáncāng 3181
412.4 kào'àn 3182
412.5 客船 (kèchuán) 3183

413 Up in the Air **3185**
413.1 dēngjī 3185
413.2 飞 (fēi) 3186
413.3 飞 (fēi) 3187
413.4 机长 (jīzhǎng) 3189
413.5 jiàngluò 3190
413.6 飞快 (fēikuài) 3191
413.7 (dialogue) 3191

414 In the Cabin **3193**
414.1 chéngwùyuán 3193
414.2 kàochuāng 3194
414.3 jīngjìcāng 3195
414.4 yùnjī 3196
414.5 ānquándài 3197

415 The Terminal **3199**
415.1 hángzhànlóu 3199
415.2 tuōyùn 3200
415.3 dēngjīpái 3201
415.4 安检 (ānjiǎn) 3202
415.5 dēngjīkǒu 3203

416 A Storm **3205**
416.1 yánwù 3205
416.2 场 (chǎng) 3206
416.3 场 (chǎng) 3207
416.4 wùjī 3208
416.5 zhuǎnjī 3209
416.6 fēixíng 3210

417 Customs **3213**
417.1 hǎiguān 3213
417.2 rùjìng 3214
417.3 chūjìng 3215
417.4 shēnbào 3216
417.5 miǎnshuì 3217

418 Checking In **3219**
418.1 zhíjī 3219
418.2 shǒuxù 3220
418.3 停飞 (tíngfēi) 3221
418.4 停 (tíng) 3222
418.5 bànlǐ 3224
418.6 chāozhòng 3225

419 Arrivals **3227**
419.1 jiējī 3227
419.2 duìhuàn 3228
419.3 wàibì 3229
419.4 guójì 3230
419.5 guónèi 3231
419.6 (dialogue) 3232

420 Parking **3235**
420.1 jiàzhào 3235
420.2 车道 (chēdào) 3236
420.3 chēwèi 3237
420.4 dàochē 3238
420.5 wéizhāng 3239

421 On the Expressway **3241**
421.1 公路 (gōnglù) 3241
421.2 高速 (gāosù) 3242
421.3 速 (sù) 3243
421.4 车速 (chēsù) 3244
421.5 shōufèizhàn 3245
421.6 chāosù 3246

422 Going North **3249**
422.1 dǎoháng 3249
422.2 **东北** (dōngběi) 3250
422.3 **北** (běi) 3251
422.4 **西北** (xīběi) 3252
422.5 **北上** (běishàng) 3253
422.6 **快速** (kuàisù) 3254

423 Going South **3257**
423.1 lùkuàng 3257
423.2 **东南** (dōngnán) 3258
423.3 **南** (nán) 3259
423.4 **西南** (xīnán) 3261
423.5 **南下** (nánxià) 3262
423.6 **南北** (nánběi) 3263

424 On the Road **3265**
424.1 suìdào 3265
424.2 diàotóu 3266
424.3 lùbiāo 3267
424.4 **时速** (shísù) 3268
424.5 **半路** (bànlù) 3269
424.6 (dialogue) 3270

425 The Hotel **3273**
425.1 zhùsù 3273
425.2 **酒店** (jiǔdiàn) 3274
425.3 **酒** (jiǔ) 3275
425.4 **客房** (kèfáng) 3277
425.5 fángkǎ 3277
425.6 dàtáng 3278

426 Booking a Room **3281**
426.1 dàchuángfáng 3281
426.2 kèmǎn 3282
426.3 **旅店** (lǚdiàn) 3283
426.4 xīngjí 3284
426.5 chāzuò 3285

427 Comings and Goings **3287**
427.1 gébì . . . 3287
427.2 来往 (láiwǎng) . . . 3288
427.3 往 (wǎng) . . . 3289
427.4 zìzhùcān . . . 3291
427.5 chuángdān . . . 3291
427.6 开往 (kāiwǎng) . . . 3292

428 Moving On **3295**
428.1 通往 (tōngwǎng) . . . 3295
428.2 前往 (qiánwǎng) . . . 3296
428.3 huíchéng . . . 3297
428.4 xíngchéng . . . 3298
428.5 发票 (fāpiào) . . . 3299

429 Home Again **3301**
429.1 lǚtú . . . 3301
429.2 shùnlù . . . 3302
429.3 dāchē . . . 3303
429.4 chūxíng . . . 3304
429.5 lùfèi . . . 3305
429.6 (dialogue) . . . 3306
429.7 (dialogue) . . . 3307

430 Seeing the Sights **3309**
430.1 guānguāng . . . 3309
430.2 gǔjì . . . 3310
430.3 jǐngqū . . . 3311
430.4 zìpāi . . . 3312
430.5 wàngjì . . . 3313

431 A Spring Outing **3315**
431.1 解说 (jiěshuō) . . . 3315
431.2 春游 (chūnyóu) . . . 3316
431.3 游 (yóu) . . . 3317
431.4 游船 (yóuchuán) . . . 3319
431.5 多 (duō) . . . 3320
431.6 héyǐng . . . 3321

432 Busy and Quiet **3323**
432.1 少 (shǎo) 3323
432.2 dànjì 3324
432.3 节假日 (jiéjiàrì) 3325
432.4 全票 (quánpiào) 3326
432.5 guānbì 3327

433 From Overseas **3329**
433.1 jiēdài 3329
433.2 海外 (hǎiwài) 3330
433.3 海 (hǎi) 3331
433.4 人山人海 (rénshānrénhǎi) 3333
433.5 huáqiáo 3334
433.6 出海 (chūhǎi) 3335

434 With a Tour Group **3337**
434.1 lǚyóutuán 3337
434.2 jíhé 3338
434.3 gòuwù 3339
434.4 liúniàn 3340
434.5 游记 (yóujì) 3341

435 At the Top **3343**
435.1 dēngshān 3343
435.2 shāndǐng 3344
435.3 日出 (rìchū) 3345
435.4 zhuàngguān 3346
435.5 下山 (xiàshān) 3347
435.6 (dialogue) 3348

436 North and South **3351**
436.1 dìxíng 3351
436.2 南方 (nánfāng) 3352
436.3 方 (fāng) 3353
436.4 北方 (běifāng) 3355
436.5 fāngyán 3356
436.6 口音 (kǒuyīn) 3357

437 Mountains and Plains 3359
437.1 山区 (shānqū) 3359
437.2 píngyuán 3360
437.3 shāmò 3361
437.4 gāoyuán 3362
437.5 yímín 3363

438 The North 3365
438.1 开发 (kāifā) 3365
438.2 北部 (běibù) 3366
438.3 部 (bù) 3367
438.4 西部 (xībù) 3369
438.5 bùfen 3369
438.6 全部 (quánbù) 3370

439 Country Life 3373
439.1 dàotián 3373
439.2 guǒyuán 3374
439.3 nóngjiālè 3375
439.4 yāzi 3376
439.5 sànxīn 3377

440 A Mountain Village 3379
440.1 gǎnjí 3379
440.2 山村 (shāncūn) 3380
440.3 村 (cūn) 3381
440.4 村长 (cūnzhǎng) 3383
440.5 cūnmín 3383
440.6 jièsù 3384

441 Out in the Open 3387
441.1 jiāoqū 3387
441.2 yěwài 3388
441.3 zhàngpeng 3389
441.4 生火 (shēnghuǒ) 3390
441.5 天然 (tiānrán) 3391
441.6 (dialogue) 3392

442 The River **3395**
442.1 duì'àn . . . 3395
442.2 河 (hé) . . . 3396
442.3 河 (hé) . . . 3397
442.4 上游 (shàngyóu) . . . 3399
442.5 zhǎngshuǐ . . . 3400
442.6 jiāng . . . 3401

443 Keeping It Clean **3403**
443.1 qīngchè . . . 3403
443.2 保护 (bǎohù) . . . 3404
443.3 护 (hù) . . . 3405
443.4 保护区 (bǎohùqū) . . . 3407
443.5 护送 (hùsòng) . . . 3408
443.6 bǔyú . . . 3408

444 An Island **3411**
444.1 qiánshuǐ . . . 3411
444.2 岛 (dǎo) . . . 3412
444.3 岛 (dǎo) . . . 3413
444.4 半岛 (bàndǎo) . . . 3415
444.5 dēngtǎ . . . 3416
444.6 fángshàishuāng . . . 3417

445 By the Sea **3419**
445.1 hǎilàng . . . 3419
445.2 yúchuán . . . 3420
445.3 shàng'àn . . . 3421
445.4 bèiké . . . 3422
445.5 tuìcháo . . . 3423

446 The Old Town **3425**
446.1 hútòng . . . 3425
446.2 城 (chéng) . . . 3426
446.3 城 (chéng) . . . 3427
446.4 古城 (gǔchéng) . . . 3429
446.5 chéngqiáng . . . 3430
446.6 进城 (jìnchéng) . . . 3431

447 On Foot **3433**
447.1 bùxíng . . . 3433
447.2 长城 (Chángchéng) . . . 3434
447.3 bùxíngjiē . . . 3435
447.4 ràolù . . . 3436
447.5 rénxíngdào . . . 3437
447.6 (dialogue) . . . 3438

448 At the Market **3441**
448.1 tānwèi . . . 3441
448.2 市场 (shìchǎng) . . . 3442
448.3 市 (shì) . . . 3443
448.4 市区 (shìqū) . . . 3444
448.5 早市 (zǎoshì) . . . 3445
448.6 bǎitān . . . 3446

449 Tastes **3449**
449.1 yèshì . . . 3449
449.2 口味 (kǒuwèi) . . . 3450
449.3 味 (wèi) . . . 3451
449.4 风味 (fēngwèi) . . . 3453
449.5 qīngdàn . . . 3454
449.6 yóunì . . . 3455

450 Local Food **3457**
450.1 hǎixiān . . . 3457
450.2 特点 (tèdiǎn) . . . 3458
450.3 特 (tè) . . . 3459
450.4 特意 (tèyì) . . . 3461
450.5 zhèngzōng . . . 3462
450.6 zhāopáicài . . . 3463

451 Specialities **3465**
451.1 chīsù . . . 3465
451.2 特色 (tèsè) . . . 3466
451.3 色 (sè) . . . 3467
451.4 出色 (chūsè) . . . 3468
451.5 sùcài . . . 3469
451.6 shèng . . . 3470

452 After the Meal **3473**
452.1 xiāohuà 3473
452.2 hǎopíng 3474
452.3 xiǎofèi 3475
452.4 天色 (tiānsè) 3476
452.5 cānjīnzhǐ 3477
452.6 (dialogue) 3478

453 Bags and Cases **3481**
453.1 bēibāo 3481
453.2 xínglixiāng 3482
453.3 sāi 3483
453.4 līn 3484
453.5 biāoqiān 3485

454 The Information Desk **3487**
454.1 fúwùtái 3487
454.2 zīxún 3488
454.3 图书 (túshū) 3489
454.4 图 (tú) 3490
454.5 zhǐlù 3492
454.6 xuānchuáncè 3493

455 Forms **3495**
455.1 xìngmíng 3495
455.2 guójí 3496
455.3 过期 (guòqī) 3497
455.4 yǒuxiào 3498
455.5 shēnqǐng 3499

456 Lost and Found **3501**
456.1 zǒusàn 3501
456.2 qiúzhù 3502
456.3 路人 (lùrén) 3503
456.4 shīzhǔ 3504
456.5 rènlǐng 3505

457 Thanks for the Help **3507**
457.1 láojià 3507
457.2 bàituō 3508

457.3 多谢 (duōxiè) 3509
457.4 gǎnjī 3510
457.5 方法 (fāngfǎ) 3511
457.6 (dialogue) 3512
457.7 (dialogue) 3513

458 How I Feel 3515
458.1 qíngxù 3515
458.2 心疼 (xīnténg) 3516
458.3 xīngfèn 3517
458.4 qīngsōng 3518
458.5 fán 3519

459 On My Mind 3521
459.1 gūdān 3521
459.2 事情 (shìqing) 3522
459.3 情 (qíng) 3523
459.4 感情 (gǎnqíng) 3525
459.5 心里话 (xīnlihuà) 3526
459.6 wěiqu 3527

460 Feeling Low 3529
460.1 yùmèn 3529
460.2 tànqì 3530
460.3 难为情 (nánwéiqíng) 3531
460.4 同情 (tóngqíng) 3532
460.5 xiànmù 3533

461 Love and Kindness 3535
461.1 pèifú 3535
461.2 爱心 (àixīn) 3536
461.3 爱 (ài) 3537
461.4 爱情 (àiqíng) 3539
461.5 心爱 (xīn'ài) 3540
461.6 pànwàng 3541

462 Surprises 3543
462.1 jīngxǐ 3543
462.2 意想不到 (yìxiǎngbúdào) 3544
462.3 hèn 3545

462.4 死心 (sǐxīn) 3546
462.5 变心 (biànxīn) 3547

463 Scared **3549**
463.1 dǎnxiǎo 3549
463.2 可怕 (kěpà) 3550
463.3 怕 (pà) 3551
463.4 xiàrén 3553
463.5 fādǒu 3554
463.6 èmèng 3555
463.7 (dialogue) 3556

464 Losing My Temper **3559**
464.1 发火 (fāhuǒ) 3559
464.2 火气 (huǒqì) 3560
464.3 气人 (qìrén) 3561
464.4 出气 (chūqì) 3562
464.5 fènnù 3563

465 Spoiling the Fun **3565**
465.1 tòngkuài 3565
465.2 扫兴 (sǎoxìng) 3566
465.3 兴 (xìng) 3567
465.4 lèguān 3568
465.5 bēiguān 3569
465.6 自信 (zìxìn) 3570

466 Keeping Calm **3573**
466.1 fādāi 3573
466.2 冷静 (lěngjìng) 3574
466.3 静 (jìng) 3575
466.4 xīntiào 3577
466.5 wēixiào 3578
466.6 píngjìng 3579

467 What Kind of Person **3581**
467.1 píqi 3581
467.2 个性 (gèxìng) 3582
467.3 性 (xìng) 3583
467.4 天性 (tiānxìng) 3585

467.5 kāilǎng 3586
467.6 huópō 3587

468 Good Points **3589**
468.1 shànliáng 3589
468.2 和气 (héqi) 3590
468.3 jiānqiáng 3591
468.4 qínkuài 3592
468.5 tǐtiē 3593

469 Gentle and Steady **3595**
469.1 chōngdòng 3595
469.2 温和 (wēnhé) 3596
469.3 温 (wēn) 3597
469.4 正经 (zhèngjīng) 3599
469.5 wěnzhòng 3600
469.6 jíxìngzi 3601
469.7 (dialogue) 3602

470 Faults **3605**
470.1 zìsī 3605
470.2 gùzhí 3606
470.3 jiāo'ào 3607
470.4 mǎhu 3608
470.5 bèn 3609

471 Eyes **3611**
471.1 yǎnlèi 3611
471.2 眼前 (yǎnqián) 3612
471.3 眼 (yǎn) 3613
471.4 小心眼 (xiǎoxīnyǎn) 3615
471.5 jìnshì 3615
471.6 zhǎyǎn 3616

472 Faces **3619**
472.1 méimao 3619
472.2 脸色 (liǎnsè) 3620
472.3 脸 (liǎn) 3621
472.4 变脸 (biànliǎn) 3623
472.5 biǎoqíng 3624

472.6 étóu 3625

473 At the Dentist **3627**
473.1 zuǐ 3627
473.2 牙医 (yáyī) 3628
473.3 牙 (yá) 3629
473.4 yáchǐ 3630
473.5 báyá 3631
473.6 bǔyá 3632

474 Strength **3635**
474.1 gēbo 3635
474.2 力气 (lìqi) 3636
474.3 力 (lì) 3637
474.4 体力 (tǐlì) 3639
474.5 用力 (yònglì) 3640
474.6 shǒuzhǐ 3641

475 Head to Knees **3643**
475.1 手心 (shǒuxīn) 3643
475.2 xīgài 3644
475.3 hòubèi 3645
475.4 身高 (shēngāo) 3646
475.5 wān 3647
475.6 (dialogue) 3648

476 Neck and Shoulders **3651**
476.1 bózi 3651
476.2 shétou 3652
476.3 jiānbǎng 3653
476.4 yáotóu 3654
476.5 téngtòng 3655

477 Inside the Body **3657**
477.1 xīnzàng 3657
477.2 gǔtou 3658
477.3 dànǎo 3659
477.4 chángwèi 3660
477.5 wèikǒu 3661

478 Injuries **3663**
478.1 tàngshāng 3663
478.2 伤口 (shāngkǒu) 3664
478.3 伤 (shāng) 3665
478.4 重伤 (zhòngshāng) 3667
478.5 niǔshāng 3668
478.6 bāozā 3668

479 Blood **3671**
479.1 shāngbā 3671
479.2 血 (xiě) 3672
479.3 血 (xiě) 3673
479.4 zhǐxuè 3674
479.5 xiànxuè 3675
479.6 xuèyā 3676

480 Symptoms **3679**
480.1 tóuyūn 3679
480.2 fāyǎng 3680
480.3 liú bítì 3681
480.4 guòmǐn 3682
480.5 shīmián 3683
480.6 (dialogue) 3684

481 Is It Serious? **3687**
481.1 要紧 (yàojǐn) 3687
481.2 紧 (jǐn) 3688
481.3 病情 (bìngqíng) 3690
481.4 病因 (bìngyīn) 3691
481.5 gǎnrǎn 3692
481.6 bìngdú 3693

482 Treatment **3695**
482.1 jízhěn 3695
482.2 zhìliáo 3696
482.3 yàopiàn 3697
482.4 xiāodú 3698
482.5 护理 (hùlǐ) 3699

483 Getting Better **3701**
483.1 hǎozhuǎn 3701
483.2 kāngfù 3702
483.3 yíngyǎng 3703
483.4 bǎojiàn 3704
483.5 mànxìng 3705

484 Staying Well **3707**
484.1 yùfáng 3707
484.2 jièjiǔ 3708
484.3 yǎngchéng 3709
484.4 píláo 3710
484.5 dǐkànglì 3711

485 Body and Mind **3713**
485.1 yālì 3713
485.2 jīngshen 3714
485.3 身心 (shēnxīn) 3715
485.4 xīntài 3716
485.5 jiǎnyā 3717
485.6 (dialogue) 3718
485.7 (dialogue) 3719

486 Looking for Work **3721**
486.1 zhāopìn 3721
486.2 jiǎnlì 3722
486.3 yìngpìn 3723
486.4 shíxí 3724
486.5 dàiyù 3725

487 A Career **3727**
487.1 hángyè 3727
487.2 事业 (shìyè) 3728
487.3 业 (yè) 3729
487.4 就业 (jiùyè) 3730
487.5 shīyè 3731
487.6 gōngchǎng 3732

488 What Do You Want to Be **3735**
488.1 gōngchéngshī 3735
488.2 chúshī 3736
488.3 kēxuéjiā 3737
488.4 fānyì 3738
488.5 zhuàn 3739

489 On the Staff **3741**
489.1 tiàocáo 3741
489.2 **职工** (zhígōng) 3742
489.3 **职** (zhí) 3743
489.4 **全职** (quánzhí) 3745
489.5 zhíwèi 3745
489.6 shēngzhí 3746

490 Pressure at Work **3749**
490.1 guǎnlǐ 3749
490.2 hézuò 3750
490.3 yèbān 3751
490.4 xīnkǔ 3752
490.5 kāichú 3753

491 The Boss **3755**
491.1 jiāxīn 3755
491.2 **上司** (shàngsi) 3756
491.3 **司** (sī) 3757
491.4 mìshū 3758
491.5 **职场** (zhíchǎng) 3759
491.6 xiàshǔ 3760
491.7 (dialogue) 3761

492 School Subjects **3763**
492.1 **语文** (yǔwén) 3763
492.2 shùxué 3764
492.3 **地理** (dìlǐ) 3765
492.4 Yīngyǔ 3766
492.5 zhuānyè 3767

493 Extra Lessons **3769**
493.1 bǔxí . . . 3769
493.2 家教 (jiājiào) . . . 3770
493.3 教 (jiào) . . . 3771
493.4 jiàoyù . . . 3773
493.5 fǔdǎo . . . 3774
493.6 请教 (qǐngjiào) . . . 3775

494 The Entrance Exam **3777**
494.1 高考 (gāokǎo) . . . 3777
494.2 考 (kǎo) . . . 3778
494.3 考生 (kǎoshēng) . . . 3779
494.4 报考 (bàokǎo) . . . 3780
494.5 考上 (kǎoshàng) . . . 3781
494.6 luòbǎng . . . 3782

495 Marks **3785**
495.1 期中 (qīzhōng) . . . 3785
495.2 考场 (kǎochǎng) . . . 3786
495.3 mǎnfēn . . . 3787
495.4 zuòbì . . . 3788
495.5 难题 (nántí) . . . 3789

496 Levels **3791**
496.1 bèishū . . . 3791
496.2 高级 (gāojí) . . . 3792
496.3 级 (jí) . . . 3793
496.4 中级 (zhōngjí) . . . 3794
496.5 chūjí . . . 3795
496.6 liújí . . . 3796

497 Learning on Your Own **3799**
497.1 自学 (zìxué) . . . 3799
497.2 课外 (kèwài) . . . 3800
497.3 bǐjì . . . 3801
497.4 zhīshi . . . 3802
497.5 shēngxué . . . 3803
497.6 (dialogue) . . . 3804

498 On the Pitch **3807**
498.1 tǐyù . . . 3807
498.2 球场 (qiúchǎng) . . . 3808
498.3 球 (qiú) . . . 3809
498.4 球门 (qiúmén) . . . 3811
498.5 shèmén . . . 3812
498.6 进球 (jìnqiú) . . . 3812

499 The Team **3815**
499.1 qiúduì . . . 3815
499.2 qiúyuán . . . 3816
499.3 duìzhǎng . . . 3817
499.4 xùnliàn . . . 3818
499.5 传球 (chuánqiú) . . . 3819

500 Match Day **3821**
500.1 huòshèng . . . 3821
500.2 球赛 (qiúsài) . . . 3822
500.3 赛 (sài) . . . 3823
500.4 juésài . . . 3825
500.5 bǐfēn . . . 3826
500.6 上场 (shàngchǎng) . . . 3827

501 Winners **3829**
501.1 yùndòngyuán . . . 3829
501.2 guànjūn . . . 3830
501.3 jīnpái . . . 3831
501.4 huòdé . . . 3832
501.5 球星 (qiúxīng) . . . 3833

502 Painting **3835**
502.1 yóuhuà . . . 3835
502.2 国画 (guóhuà) . . . 3836
502.3 画 (huà) . . . 3837
502.4 画家 (huàjiā) . . . 3839
502.5 名画 (mínghuà) . . . 3839
502.6 huàzhǎn . . . 3840

503 Art **3843**
503.1 书法 (shūfǎ) 3843
503.2 yìshù 3844
503.3 zuòpǐn 3845
503.4 chuàngzuò 3846
503.5 年画 (niánhuà) 3847
503.6 (dialogue) 3848

504 Songs **3851**
504.1 gēcí 3851
504.2 儿歌 (érgē) 3852
504.3 歌 (gē) 3853
504.4 国歌 (guógē) 3855
504.5 míngē 3856
504.6 yǎnchàng 3857

505 Dancing **3859**
505.1 wǔdǎo 3859
505.2 舞会 (wǔhuì) 3860
505.3 舞 (wǔ) 3861
505.4 wǔbàn 3863
505.5 wǔtái 3864
505.6 páiliàn 3865

506 Music on Stage **3867**
506.1 yuèduì 3867
506.2 yǎnzòu 3868
506.3 xiǎotíqín 3869
506.4 Jīngjù 3870
506.5 gēmí 3871

507 Fathers and Sons **3873**
507.1 xiōngdì 3873
507.2 父子 (fùzǐ) 3874
507.3 父 (fù) 3875
507.4 父女 (fùnǚ) 3876
507.5 fūqī 3877
507.6 zhǎngbèi 3878

508 Brothers and Sisters 3881
508.1 jiěmèi . . . 3881
508.2 xiōngmèi . . . 3882
508.3 dúshēngzǐnǚ . . . 3883
508.4 qīfu . . . 3884
508.5 dǒngshì . . . 3885
508.6 (dialogue) . . . 3886

509 Parents 3889
509.1 当家 (dāngjiā) . . . 3889
509.2 父母 (fùmǔ) . . . 3890
509.3 母 (mǔ) . . . 3891
509.4 母女 (mǔnǚ) . . . 3892
509.5 母语 (mǔyǔ) . . . 3893
509.6 后妈 (hòumā) . . . 3894

510 Grandparents 3897
510.1 wàipó . . . 3897
510.2 sūnzi . . . 3898
510.3 sūnnǚ . . . 3899
510.4 疼爱 (téng'ài) . . . 3900
510.5 hǒng . . . 3901

511 Close Family 3903
511.1 亲人 (qīnrén) . . . 3903
511.2 亲 (qīn) . . . 3904
511.3 父亲 (fùqīn) . . . 3906
511.4 母亲 (mǔqīn) . . . 3907
511.5 亲生 (qīnshēng) . . . 3908
511.6 亲自 (qīnzì) . . . 3908

512 Dreams 3911
512.1 zhìxiàng . . . 3911
512.2 zhuīqiú . . . 3912
512.3 成才 (chéngcái) . . . 3913
512.4 成名 (chéngmíng) . . . 3914
512.5 名校 (míngxiào) . . . 3915

513 Ambitions **3917**
513.1 chuàngyè 3917
513.2 dádào 3918
513.3 zhēngqǔ 3919
513.4 fèndòu 3920
513.5 亲手 (qīnshǒu) 3921
513.6 (dialogue) 3922
513.7 (dialogue) 3923

514 When the Weather Turns **3925**
514.1 shǎndiàn 3925
514.2 línyǔ 3926
514.3 léiyǔ 3927
514.4 dòngjiāng 3928
514.5 rónghuà 3929

515 Four Seasons **3931**
515.1 hánlěng 3931
515.2 四季 (sìjì) 3932
515.3 季 (jì) 3933
515.4 雨季 (yǔjì) 3935
515.5 bìshǔ 3936
515.6 shōuhuò 3937

516 Trees and Leaves **3939**
516.1 luòyè 3939
516.2 树 (shù) 3940
516.3 树 (shù) 3941
516.4 果树 (guǒshù) 3943
516.5 shùlín 3944
516.6 chéngshú 3945

517 Light in the Dark **3947**
517.1 tiānliàng 3947
517.2 光 (guāng) 3948
517.3 光 (guāng) 3949
517.4 发光 (fāguāng) 3950
517.5 星光 (xīngguāng) 3951
517.6 huánghūn 3952

518 Sunshine **3955**
518.1 qínglǎng 3955
518.2 阳光 (yángguāng) 3956
518.3 阳 (yáng) 3957
518.4 太阳能 (tàiyángnéng) 3958
518.5 dǎsǎn 3959
518.6 dàwù 3960

519 Out in Nature **3963**
519.1 春光 (chūnguāng) 3963
519.2 qīngchén 3964
519.3 四季如春 (sìjì rú chūn) 3965
519.4 xuějǐng 3966
519.5 chéngliáng 3967
519.6 (dialogue) 3968

520 Around the House **3971**
520.1 家电 (jiādiàn) 3971
520.2 开关 (kāiguān) 3972
520.3 rèshuǐqì 3973
520.4 nuǎnqì 3974
520.5 shěngdiàn 3975

521 Keeping House **3977**
521.1 shuā 3977
521.2 féng 3978
521.3 bùzhì 3979
521.4 zhěngqí 3980
521.5 wèishēng 3981

522 Something Needs Fixing **3983**
522.1 lòushuǐ 3983
522.2 上门 (shàngmén) 3984
522.3 shuǐfèi 3985
522.4 ménlíng 3986
522.5 dìbǎn 3987

523 Buying and Selling **3989**
523.1 pīfā 3989
523.2 买卖 (mǎimai) 3990

523.3 卖 (mài) . . . 3991
523.4 卖家 (màijiā) . . . 3993
523.5 买家 (mǎijiā) . . . 3993
523.6 língshòu . . . 3994

524 Half Price **3997**
524.1 jiézhàng . . . 3997
524.2 半价 (bànjià) . . . 3998
524.3 价 (jià) . . . 3999
524.4 要价 (yàojià) . . . 4001
524.5 还价 (huánjià) . . . 4002
524.6 wùjià . . . 4003

525 At Your Service **4005**
525.1 zhōudào . . . 4005
525.2 格外 (géwài) . . . 4006
525.3 格 (gé) . . . 4007
525.4 shòuhuòyuán . . . 4009
525.5 tóusù . . . 4010
525.6 tuìkuǎn . . . 4011
525.7 (dialogue) . . . 4012

526 How Heavy? **4015**
526.1 chēng . . . 4015
526.2 gōngjīn . . . 4016
526.3 重量 (zhòngliàng) . . . 4017
526.4 量 (liàng) . . . 4018
526.5 大量 (dàliàng) . . . 4020
526.6 少量 (shǎoliàng) . . . 4021

527 Ordering Online **4023**
527.1 xiàdān . . . 4023
527.2 bāozhuāng . . . 4024
527.3 huìyuán . . . 4025
527.4 yōuhuì . . . 4026
527.5 格子 (gézi) . . . 4027

528 By Chance **4029**
528.1 pèngqiǎo . . . 4029
528.2 不得不 (bùdébù) . . . 4030

528.3 chōuqiān 4031
528.4 dǎdǔ 4032
528.5 ǒurán 4033

529 Good Luck, Bad Luck 4035
529.1 dǎoméi 4035
529.2 运气 (yùnqi) 4036
529.3 运 (yùn) 4037
529.4 走运 (zǒuyùn) 4039
529.5 xìngyùn 4039
529.6 mìngyùn 4040

530 Winning a Prize 4043
530.1 cǎipiào 4043
530.2 chōujiǎng 4044
530.3 zhòngjiǎng 4045
530.4 jiǎngpǐn 4046
530.5 tóujiǎng 4047

531 A Lucky Escape 4049
531.1 tuōxiǎn 4049
531.2 jīhū 4050
531.3 jiǎoxìng 4051
531.4 búxìng 4052
531.5 shīshǒu 4053
531.6 (dialogue) 4054

532 Hoping for More 4057
532.1 有望 (yǒuwàng) 4057
532.2 望 (wàng) 4058
532.3 bābude 4060
532.4 期望 (qīwàng) 4061
532.5 如意 (rúyì) 4062
532.6 zhǐwàng 4063

533 I Hope So 4065
533.1 xiàngwǎng 4065
533.2 希望 (xīwàng) 4066
533.3 希 (xī) 4067
533.4 kěwàng 4069

533.5 juéwàng 4070
533.6 心想事成 (xīnxiǎng shìchéng) 4071

534 I'd Rather **4073**
534.1 nìngkě 4073
534.2 jǐnliàng 4074
534.3 假如 (jiǎrú) 4075
534.4 xǔnuò 4076
534.5 万事如意 (wànshì rúyì) 4077

535 If You're Willing **4079**
535.1 愿意 (yuànyì) 4079
535.2 愿 (yuàn) 4080
535.3 愿望 (yuànwàng) 4082
535.4 如愿 (rúyuàn) 4083
535.5 自愿 (zìyuàn) 4084
535.6 但愿 (dànyuàn) 4085

536 When Wishes Come True **4087**
536.1 成真 (chéngzhēn) 4087
536.2 yuánmèng 4088
536.3 měihǎo 4089
536.4 mèngjiàn 4090
536.5 pàntou 4091
536.6 (dialogue) 4092

537 As It Turns Out **4095**
537.1 起因 (qǐyīn) 4095
537.2 原来 (yuánlái) 4096
537.3 原 (yuán) 4097
537.4 dǎozhì 4099
537.5 zàochéng 4100
537.6 xiàoguǒ 4101

538 One Thing Leads to Another **4103**
538.1 miǎnde 4103
538.2 cóng'ér 4104
538.3 本身 (běnshēn) 4105
538.4 chǎnshēng 4106
538.5 gēnběn 4107

539 Whose Fault? 4109
539.1 rě . . . 4109
539.2 怪 (guài) . . . 4110
539.3 怪 (guài) . . . 4111
539.4 怪事 (guàishì) . . . 4113
539.5 chīkuī . . . 4114
539.6 chuǎnghuò . . . 4115

540 So That's Why 4117
540.1 古怪 (gǔguài) . . . 4117
540.2 liánlei . . . 4118
540.3 nánmiǎn . . . 4119
540.4 前因后果 (qiányīn hòuguǒ) . . . 4120
540.5 怎么回事 (zěnme huí shì) . . . 4121

541 If It Weren't for You 4123
541.1 要不是 (yàobúshì) . . . 4123
541.2 duōkuī . . . 4124
541.3 gǎishàn . . . 4125
541.4 zhǔyào . . . 4126
541.5 要么 (yàome) . . . 4127
541.6 (dialogue) . . . 4128
541.7 (dialogue) . . . 4129

Pronunciation & Character Guide 4131

Glossary 4135

Review Questions 4321

Answer Key 4345

Sources for this starter edition 4373

Index 4375

Chapter 1

Nǐ Hǎo — Hello, Character by Character

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (2) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone in Mandarin and answer when greeted, reading both characters unaided and saying the greeting with the tone a speaker actually uses rather than the one the dictionary prints.
>
> *A two-line meeting in which both voices say the same word — read from the characters alone, with the first third tone raised by sandhi.*

1.1 mā má mǎ mà — one syllable, four words

Nothing to recall yet. Before the first Chinese word arrives, one thing your voice is about to be asked to do that English never asks of it.

The sounds and tones in this word

In English, pitch carries mood. *Really.* and *Really?* are the same word, said two ways.
In Mandarin, **pitch is part of the word**, exactly the way a consonant is. Take the syllable *ma* and give it four different pitches and you get four unrelated words:

- **mā** — held high and flat, one steady note. *Mother.*
- **má** — rising, like the pitch on a surprised English "huh?". *Hemp.*

- **mǎ** — dipping low, a little creaky. *Horse.*
- **mà** — falling sharply, like a clipped "No!". *To scold.*

There is a fifth, the **neutral** tone: short, light, no mark written at all. The accent over the vowel is how the romanization writes the tone: a flat bar in **ā**, a rising stroke in **á**, a hook in **ǎ**, a falling stroke in **à**. The Chinese characters themselves record no tone anywhere, so the accent is a teaching aid, not part of the writing.
Say all four in order now, slowly: **mā, má, mǎ, mà**. *Twice through.*

Writing — trace four visible paths

Keep the model visible. With a finger first, then a pencil, trace only the mark above each **a**: **ā, á, ǎ, à**. Move flat, up, down-then-up, and down. Say the matching pitch while your pencil moves.

Stop after one slow pass. This is not a memory test, and these pinyin marks are not Chinese characters. The next lesson will give your hand its first two-stroke character; this tiny step only lets pitch become a line you can see and follow.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **mā** high and flat, then **mà** falling — hear how far apart they are
- *Answer:* if you change the pitch of a Mandarin syllable, what changes?

Before you move on

Which accent tells you to dip low? (The hook, as in **ǎ**.) Does changing a Mandarin tone change how you feel about a word, or which word it is? (Which word it is.)
Source: the tone inventory this track keeps

1.2 你 — "you", and the first character

Say the four tones on *ma* once, in order. Hold the third one — low and dipping. The first Chinese word carries exactly that

pitch.

The sounds and tones in this word

nǐ. The *n* is the English *n*; the *i* is the *ee* of "see". The hook over it is the **third tone**: start low, stay low, let it creak. *Twice through.*

Script — 你, and the person hiding on its left

Chinese is not written with letters. It is written with **characters**, each an evenly sized square block, and each block built from smaller recurring pieces called **components**.

你 has two of them: a narrow piece on the left, a wider one on the right.

The narrow left piece is the "person" component, *rén*. On its own, the character for a person is two legs walking. Pushed to the left edge of a block, it is squashed upright: one short slant over one vertical.

The right piece, *ěr*, is there for its *sound*, not its meaning. Chinese builds most of its characters this way — one component pointing at the meaning, another at the pronunciation.

Stroke order is a real, taught system here: top before bottom, left before right. So the person piece first, then the sound piece. The writing lessons hand you each piece, stroke by stroke.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

你 *nǐ* — **you**, addressing one person.
Here this book has to be honest with you. A related language lets a new word be anchored to English words you already own through a shared ancestor — Spanish *gracias* to *grace* and *gratitude*, all from Latin *gratia*. **Chinese shares no ancestor with English.** There is no cousin web for *nǐ*, and inventing one would be worse than having none.
What replaces it is what you just read: the character is itself decomposable, and its pieces mean things. 你 carries a person on its left because it is about a person. That is the hook — not history you share with English, but structure you can see.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **nǐ** — low and dipping, not flat
- *Read it:* 你 — point to the person piece, then the sound piece

Before you move on

Which half of 你 is the person? (The narrow left one.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

1.3 好 — "good", and what replaces etymology here

Say the word for "you" without looking. Which of its two components is the person? Now hold that low, dipping pitch — the next word wants the same one.

The sounds and tones in this word

hǎo. The *h* is a little rougher than English *h*, scraped at the back of the mouth. The *ao* is one gliding vowel, the *ow* of "how". The hook accent is the same third tone you already met: low, dipping, creaky. *Twice through.*

Script — 好, a woman beside a child

Two components again, side by side. The left one is the character for "woman", said *nǚ*: a crossing stroke, a curved leg, a horizontal through the middle. The right one is "child", said *zǐ*: a hooked top, a hooked vertical, a horizontal arm. Left before right, as always.

Notice what just happened. Woman and child are not letters spelling out the sound *hǎo* — neither is pronounced anything like it. They are whole characters with their own meanings, reused as building blocks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好 *hǎo* — **good**, and also **well**.
A woman beside a child, and the character means "good". That picture is the hook — and it stands in for the cousin web that a related language would supply, because **Chinese and English share no ancestor** and there is no honest chain from *hǎo* to any English word. Two cautions, because a memory aid that pretends to be history rots:

- "Woman + child = good" is the **traditional gloss**. It is genuinely useful for remembering the shape, but palaeographers

do not all accept it as the historical origin; some read the child component as a phonetic element instead. A picture that helps, not a proven derivation.

- Component glosses are hooks, not translations. 好 does not "mean" woman-child. It means good.

The word itself is inherited from Middle Chinese *xawX*, "good" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The picture belongs to the writing, not to the word.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **hǎo** — low and dipping, the *ow* of "how"
- *Read it:* 好 — point to the woman on the left, then the child on the right
- *Answer:* why does this track use component pictures instead of English cousins?

Before you move on

What does 好 mean? (Good, or well.) Is its woman-and-child picture a proven etymology? (No — a traditional and useful gloss, disputed as history.)
Source: Unicode Han database, character 好

1.4 你好 — the greeting, assembled from two things you already have

Two characters, both already yours. Say the one that means "you". Say the one that means "good". Now put them in that order and you have said hello — but say it slowly for one more moment, because the tones are about to do something.

The exchange

你好 *nǐ hǎo!* Hello.

你好 *nǐ hǎo!* Hello.

The greeting and its answer are the same word. Say it to one person you have just met, at any hour of the day.

Grammar Lens — a word can be more than one character

English counts a word in **letters**. Chinese does not have letters, so the tempting guess is that it counts a word in **characters** — one character, one word. That guess is wrong, and correcting it early saves a great deal of confusion.
A character writes one **syllable** and usually one **meaningful piece**. A **word** is one or more of those pieces:

- 你 — one character, one word: *you*
- 好 — one character, one word: *good*
- 你好 — two characters, still **one word**: *hello*

Nobody hearing 你好 parses it as "you good", any more than an English speaker hears "good" and "bye" inside *goodbye*. The pieces are visible, which makes the word easy to remember; the whole is what it means.

Why it's said this way

你好 is safe, neutral, and understood everywhere — which is exactly why a course teaches it first. But it is worth knowing that it is used less freely than English "hello". Between people who already know each other, a Mandarin speaker is more likely to open with a small situational remark than with 你好 at all. Reserve it for meeting someone, and you will sound right.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

你好 is a Chinese compound of two inherited words: *hǎo*, "good", from Middle Chinese *xawX*, and *nǐ*, "you", usually traced to the older second-person word *nyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

- *Say it:* **nǐ hǎo** — greeting someone you have just met

- *Say it:* **nǐ hǎo** — answering that same greeting
- *Answer:* how many characters is this word, and how many words is it?

Before you move on

Which character comes first, and what does it mean on its own? (你, "you".) Is 你好 one word or two? (One.)
Source: Unicode Han database, characters 你 and 好

1.5 ní hǎo — why the greeting is not said the way it is written

Say the greeting once, slowly, giving both syllables the low dipping third tone you were taught. It should feel awkward in the mouth. That awkwardness is the whole lesson.

Grammar Lens — one rule, and it is not optional

When two third tones come one after the other, the first is spoken as a second (rising) tone.
So the greeting, written **nǐ hǎo**, is actually said **ní hǎo** — the first syllable climbs instead of dipping. *Twice through.*
Nothing about this shows in the writing. Dictionaries print **nǐ hǎo**, because that is the citation tone each word carries on its own, and the two characters never change at all. A learner who trusts only what is written will say the commonest greeting in the language wrong every time.
Why does it happen? Two dipping tones in a row would need the voice to sink, climb, sink and climb again inside a fifth of a second. Speakers do not do that; the first one gives way. This is a real rule of the sound system, not a sloppy shortcut, and every native speaker applies it without thinking.
Compare it to what English does with *"the"*: written one way, said *thuh* before a consonant and *thee* before a vowel, and no English speaker thinks of that as two words. The difference is that here the change lands on **pitch** — the same property that distinguishes one word from another.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **ní hǎo** — first syllable rising, second dipping
- *Say it:* it again, at speaking speed, without the pause between them
- *Answer:* which spelling changes when the rule applies — pinyin, characters, or neither?

Before you move on

Two third tones meet. What happens to the first? (It rises.) What happens to the characters? (Nothing.)
Source: Chinese Text Project, on tone in Mandarin

1.6 好 again — proof, on a character you own, that tone is the word

Name the character built from a woman and a child, and say what it means. Hold its tone: low and dipping.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

The very same character, 好, has a second reading — and the only thing that separates the two is the tone:

- 好 *hǎo*, dipping third tone — **good**
- 好 *hào*, sharply falling fourth tone — **to be fond of, to like**

Same strokes. Same components. Same shape on the page. Two words. This is the cleanest proof available of what the first lesson claimed. Tone is not decoration on a word; it is *inside* the word, doing the job a consonant does in English. Change *hǎo* to *hào* and you have not said "good" with feeling — you have said a different word, the way *bat* and *pat* are different words.
The two readings are related in meaning, and the relation is a good hook: what is **good** is what one is **fond of**. That is a link inside Chinese, between two readings of one character. It is not a link to English. There is none.
You are not asked to produce **hào** yet. Recognising it is the point: when a familiar character turns up wearing an unfamiliar tone, the

tone is telling you this is a different word.
Both readings are inherited from Middle Chinese: the Guangyun lists *xawX*, "good", and *xawH*, "to be fond of" (in Baxter's transcription). Making a related word by moving it into the departing tone, the *H* of these spellings, is a well-known pattern of Middle Chinese.

Your turn

- *Answer:* **hǎo** or **hào** — which one means "good"?
- *Answer:* what changed between them, and what stayed the same?
- *Answer:* which two components is this character built from?

Before you move on

One character carried two words today. What told them apart? (Only the tone.)
Source: Unicode Han database, character 好

1.7 Practice — greet someone, and be greeted back

Retrieve the two words separately first: the one meaning "you", then the one meaning "good". Do not run them together yet.

The exchange

A: 你好 *ní hǎo!* B: 你好 *ní hǎo!*

Two lines, one word, both voices. Every piece is already yours: the characters from their own lessons, the meaning from the greeting lesson, the rising first syllable from the sandhi rule. Nothing new is hiding here.

Say A's line, pause, then answer as B. *Twice through.*

What you've built this chapter

Four things, and only one of them is vocabulary:

- 你 is a person component plus a sound component; 好 is woman beside child. Characters are built from parts.

- Those parts are the memory hook this track uses, because Chinese and English share no ancestor and therefore no cousin web.
- 你好 is two characters and one word. Characters are not letters.
- Pitch is part of the word, and a neighbouring word can change it without changing a stroke.

Your turn

- *Say it:* greet someone you have just met
- *Say it:* answer that greeting
- *Read it:* 你好 aloud from the characters alone, with no pinyin

Before you move on

Run both lines once more. If the first syllable dips instead of rising, go back to the sandhi lesson only — not to the whole chapter.
Source: Unicode Han database, characters 你 and 好

Chapter 2

Reading the Greeting — One Piece at a Time

Modes: ✓ **pen** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write each component the greeting's two characters are built from, and then assemble both characters from those pieces rather than recalling them as whole shapes.
>
> *The second assembly, built from two components the reader wrote individually a moment earlier — and a caution that the memorable story about why it means what it means is a story, not a source.*

2.1 人 — two strokes, and a person walking

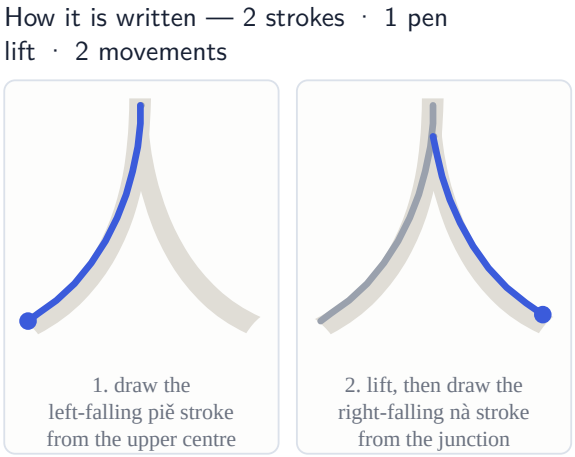
You have heard Mandarin pitch. Now you meet the writing, and this book will hand it to you **one piece at a time** — never a character you have not been shown the parts of first.

This is the whole first piece:

人

Two strokes. That is the entire character.

Script — the shape



How 人 is written, stroke by stroke

人 *rén* means **person**.

Look at it before you read another word about it. A stroke leaning down-left, a stroke leaning down-right, meeting at the top. **It is a figure standing on two legs, seen from the side.** You are not being asked to take that on faith — the oldest surviving forms of this character, scratched into ox bone three thousand years ago, are recognisably a standing person, and the two legs are the part that lasted.

Write it in this order, and the order is not a suggestion:

1. the **left** stroke, from the top down to the lower left — a falling sweep
2. the **right** stroke, starting near the top of the first and pressing down to the lower right

Left before right. Almost every character you meet will obey it, and it is worth meeting here — on a character with two strokes — rather than later on one with fifteen.

The pitch is **second tone**: *rén* rises, like the end of an English question.

Your turn — copy with the model visible

Keep 人 visible. Point to the left stroke, then the right. Copy the character once immediately below the model: left stroke first, then right. Say *rén* as you finish it, and compare the meeting point at the top before moving on.

This is guided copy, not a memory test. One careful copy is enough.

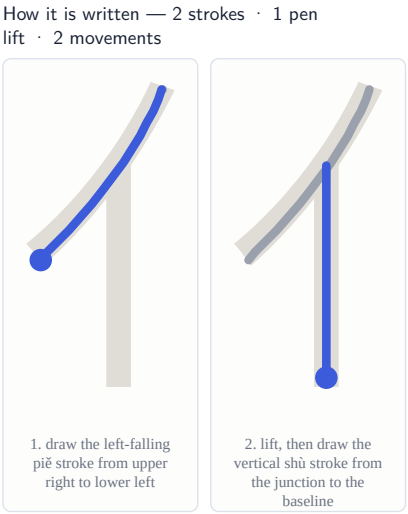
Before you move on

Which stroke goes first — the one leaning left, or the one leaning right? (The **left**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

2.2 亻 — the same person, standing sideways

Write the two-stroke character for *person* once, from memory. Left stroke, then right.

Script — one character, two postures



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–2 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 亻 is written, stroke by stroke

Every Chinese character is written inside an **evenly sized square block** — whether it has two strokes or twenty, it occupies the same footprint. That one fact drives everything you are about to see.

Because when two pieces have to share a block, one of them must get out of the way. Here is what *person* looks like when it moves to the left edge to make room:

亻

Still two strokes. Still the same piece. But the wide-legged stance has been pulled upright into **one short slant on top of one long vertical**, narrow enough that something else can sit beside it.

This is not a different character. It is the same one, squashed. Chinese does this constantly, and the squashed forms are called **components**. When you see 亻 at the left edge of a block, the character is telling you: *this word is about a person.*

Write it:

1. the **short slant**, down-left, at the top
2. the **long vertical**, dropping from the middle of that slant

Top before bottom — the second of the two rules.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 人, then 亻 beside it. Notice you did not learn a new piece — you learned a new **posture**.
- *Notice:* 亻 is tall and thin because it is only using the left half of its square.

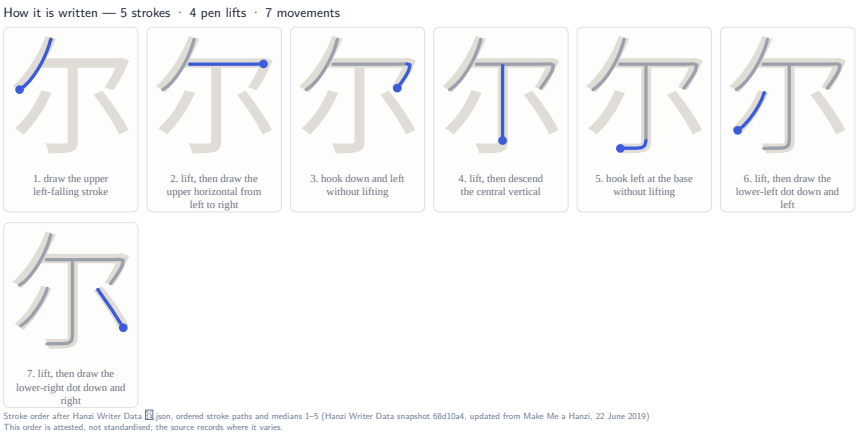
Before you move on

Why does *person* change shape at all? (To leave room in the square for whatever stands beside it.)
Source: Unicode CJK Radicals Supplement chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

2.3 尔 — a piece that is there for its sound

The narrow upright person — draw it once. Short slant, long vertical.

Script — the other kind of component



How 尔 is written, stroke by stroke

So far a component has meant something: the person piece says *this is about a person.* Here is a component that works the other way.

尔

尔 *ěr*. Five strokes: a short slant across the top, a broad cover beneath it, a central vertical that finishes with a hook, then a small stroke each side of it, left first.

Now the part that matters, and it is the single most useful fact about Chinese writing:

Most characters are built from one component pointing at the MEANING and another pointing at the SOUND. When 尔 turns up inside a character, it is usually there because the word sounds something like *ěr* — not because the word has anything to do with what 尔 means on its own.

That is a strange idea when your reading habits come from an alphabet, where every piece is sound and none is meaning. It is also a relief: it means characters are not arbitrary pictures to be memorised whole. They are **built**,

from a small stock of pieces, and once you know the pieces you can often guess both halves of a character you have never seen.

The pitch is **third tone**: *ěr* dips low.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 尔 — top slant, cover, the middle and its hook, then the two dots
- *Say it:* **ěr**, low and dipping

Before you move on

Two kinds of component, then. One tells you what a word is **about**; the other tells you roughly how it **sounds**. Which kind is 尔?
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

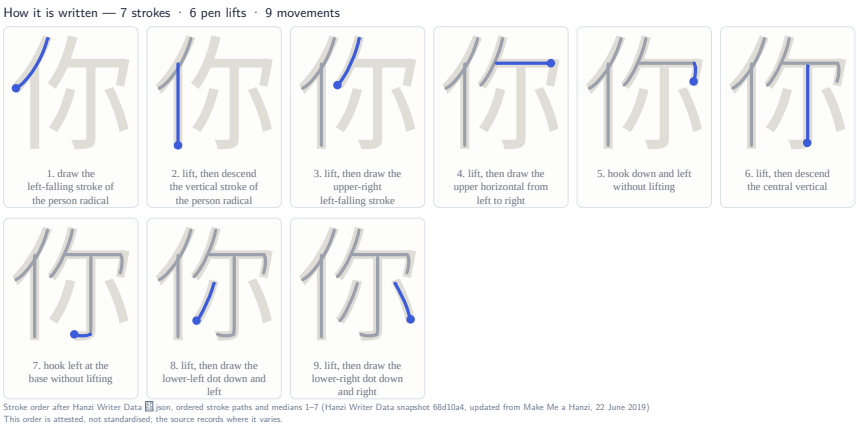
2.4 Putting two pieces together — and reading the result

Two pieces, both already yours. Draw them side by side:

亻 尔

The narrow person on the left. The five-stroke sound piece on the right.

Script — the assembly



How 你 is written, stroke by stroke

Push them into one square block and you have written a character:

亻 + 尔 → 你

Read it the way you now know how to read it, half at a time:

- the **left** half is the person component. So this word is **about a person**.
- the **right** half is the sound piece *ěr*. So this word **sounds something like** *ěr*.

The word is *nǐ*. And that is the honest state of the sound half — *nǐ* and *ěr* are close, not identical. **A sound component gets you into the neighbourhood, not to the door.** Sound components were chosen over two thousand years of pronunciation change, and the pronunciations moved out from under them. Expect a hint, and you will be right most of the time; expect a rule, and Chinese will embarrass you weekly.

Write it left before right, exactly as you learned each half:

1. 亻 — short slant, long vertical
2. 尔 — top slant, cover, then the middle and its hook

Seven strokes in total, and you did not memorise a single new one.

What you've built

Stop and take the measure of what just happened, because it is the reason this book teaches script this way.
You have not been shown a picture and asked to remember it. You were given two pieces, one at a time, and then shown that a character is what you get when they share a square. **The next character works the same way, and so does the one after that.** There are only a few hundred components in common use, and they recombine — which is what makes several thousand characters a climb rather than a cliff.

Your turn — look, cover, rebuild

Copy 你 once while the model is visible: complete 亻, then complete 尔. Point to the meaning half and the sound half. Now cover every model, wait ten seconds, and rebuild the character from memory. Uncover and compare the two halves separately; correct only the half that stalled.

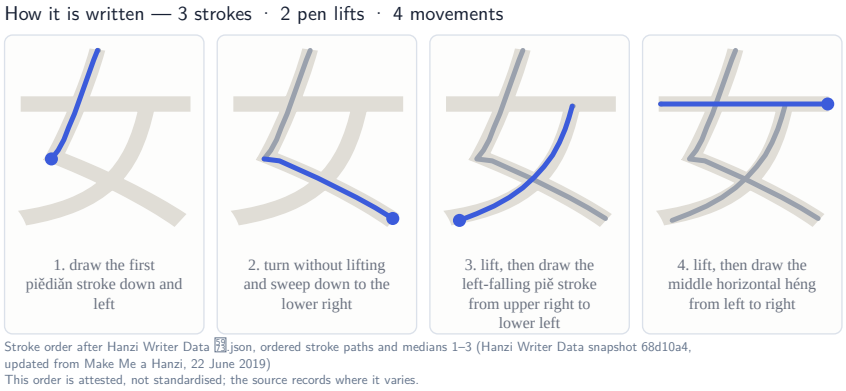
Before you move on

Two pieces, one block, and a character you can take apart again whenever you need to. Which half would you look at to guess the pronunciation?
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

2.5 女 — three strokes, seated

One character so far assembles from two known halves. Draw it, and name each half as you write it.

Script — the shape



How 女 *is written, stroke by stroke*

A new piece, and like the first one it is old enough to still look like what it meant:

女

女 *nǚ* — **woman**. Three strokes.

The oracle-bone form is a **kneeling or seated figure with the arms crossed in front**. The modern character keeps the crossing: that long horizontal running right across the middle is the arms, and the two curving strokes beneath and around it are the folded body. It has straightened out over three thousand years, but nothing has been added or taken away.

Write it in this order:

1. the stroke that starts upper-right and **curves down and left**
2. the stroke that crosses it, going **down-left then flicking right**
3. the **long horizontal**, last, sweeping across both

That third stroke going last is worth noticing — a long horizontal that crosses everything else usually waits until the end.

The pitch is **third tone**, and the vowel is the rounded *ü*: say *ee* and then push your lips into a whistle without changing the tongue.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 女 — and let the crossing bar go last
- *Say it:* **nǚ**, low and dipping, lips rounded

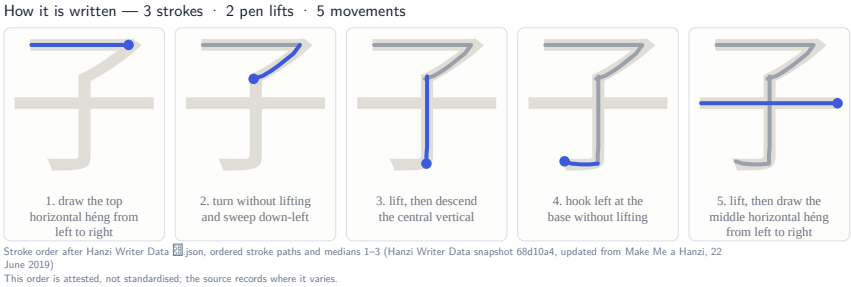
Before you move on

Which stroke comes last, and why? (The **long horizontal** — a bar that crosses the whole character usually waits.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

2.6 子 — three strokes, a child

Three strokes, crossing bar last. Draw the seated figure you met a moment ago.

Script — the shape



How 子 is written, stroke by stroke

子

子 *zǐ* — **child**. Three strokes again, and again a figure you can still see once you are told where to look.

This one is an infant drawn **from the front**: a large head on top, two arms out to the sides, and the legs bound together so they read as one stroke rather than two. Babies were carried swaddled, and the character kept the bundle.

Write it:

1. the short stroke across the **top**, turning down — the head
2. the **vertical with a hook**, dropping through the middle — the wrapped body
3. the **horizontal** across the middle — the arms

The pitch is **third tone**. The *z* is not the English *z* of *zoo*: it is the *ds* at the end of English *beds*, made with the tongue tip against the teeth.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 子 — head, hooked body, then arms
- *Notice:* two characters now, both three strokes, both once pictures of people. Draw them side by side and compare which parts are curved.

Before you move on

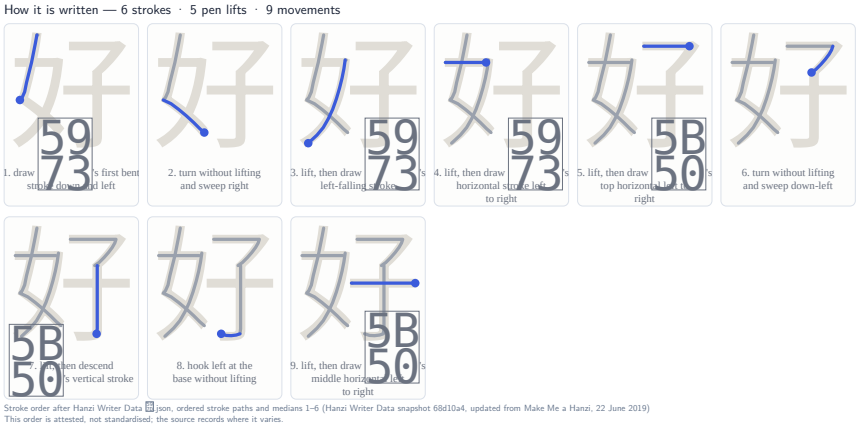
The stroke that runs down the middle carries a hook. What part of the picture is it? (The **wrapped body and legs**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

2.7 Two pieces again — and a warning about the story

Both pieces are yours. Draw them side by side:

女 子

Script — the assembly



How 好 *is written, stroke by stroke*

Squeeze them into one block, woman on the left, child on the right:

女 + 子 → 好

好 *hǎo*. Six strokes, three from each half, and again nothing new.

Note what is **different** about this assembly. The first one you built had a meaning half and a sound half. This one has **two meaning halves and no sound half at all** — neither piece sounds like *hǎo*. Both kinds of character are common, and you cannot tell which kind you are holding until you look.

When 女 is squeezed into the left of a block its long crossing bar stops short rather than sweeping past the middle, so as not to collide with what stands beside it. Same piece, narrower posture — the same accommodation you already saw the person component make.

What you've built — and a caution

You will find it said that 好 means *good* **because** a woman with a child is a good thing.

Treat that as a story, not as evidence. It is memorable, it is repeated everywhere, and there is no agreement among specialists that it is what happened — competing accounts read the woman as the sound half in an older pronunciation, or read the pair as a woman *caring for* a child. This book will hand you an etymology when there is

a source behind it and tell you plainly when there is not, and this is one of the second kind.
Use the pairing as a **memory hook**, which it genuinely is. Do not file it as a fact about why the word means what it means.

Your turn — from the spoken word to the page

Copy 好 once while looking: finish 女, then 子. Notice that the crossing bar on the left stops before the right half.

Now close the page. Have a person or screen reader say *hǎo* with no character visible. Wait ten seconds, write 好 from the spoken cue, then uncover it. Compare the left half and right half separately. If one half stalled, revisit only its three-stroke lesson before trying the dictation again.

Before you move on

Six strokes, two pieces, and you built both pieces yourself. What is the one claim in this lesson you should NOT repeat as fact?
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

Chapter 3

One to Five — Where the Character Is the Count

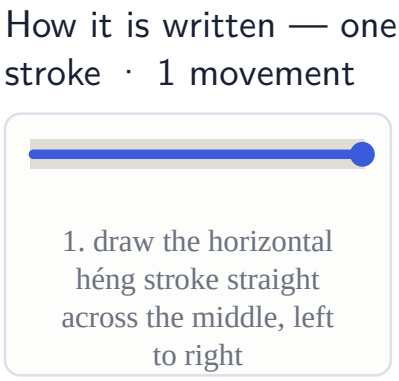
Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 👁 **eyes** (1) ✒ **pen** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 11 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from one to five in Mandarin and read all five characters cold and out of order, and I know which of them I could have worked out and which I simply had to learn.
>
> *The five numerals read out of sequence, then off a lift panel with the fourth floor missing — and the reader knows why it is missing.*

3.1 一 — one stroke, and that is the character

Two chapters ago a character was a block to take apart. You learned pieces first, then the characters they build. This chapter asks nothing of the sort. Put the pieces down.

Script — the whole character



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 一.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–1 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 一 is written, stroke by stroke

Here it is:

一

That is not a fragment. **That is the character.** One horizontal stroke, drawn left to right across the middle of the square, and nothing else.

Write it: **one héng stroke, left to right.** No pen lifts, because there is nothing to lift between. It is the shortest character you will ever write.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 一 — one stroke, left to right, straight and level

Before you move on

A character you did not have to decompose. How many times did you lift the pen? (**Not once**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

3.2 一 — one, and the number is the strokes

Write it: the shape you just learned — one stroke, left to right

The sounds and tones in this word

一 *yī* means **one**.
Take those two facts together, because their meeting is the point: **One stroke. And it means one.**
Chinese will do this exactly three times, and you are about to meet all three in a row. It is the gentlest corner of a writing system with a reputation for being anything but.
Now the sound, and here is something new. Every word this book has given you so far has dipped (*nǐ*, *hǎo*, *ěr*) or risen (*rén*). This one does neither.
First tone: high and flat. Start high and stay there — not a question, not a statement, just a held note. Hum a single steady pitch and put *yi* on it. *Twice through:*
One honest note, so it does not surprise you later. **一 does not always keep this tone.** In front of certain syllables it shifts to *yí* or *yì* — the same kind of change that turned 你好 into *ní hǎo*. Counting is exactly where it stays *yī*, so counting is where this book leaves it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一 *yī* is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jit*, "one" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The single stroke is the history of the character; the word is the inherited one.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **yī** — high and flat, held
- *Read it:* 一 — say it, then say how many strokes it has

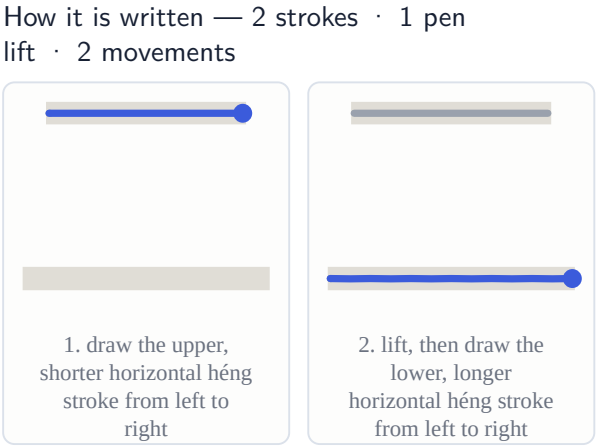
Before you move on

Which tone is *yī* — the dipping one, or the flat one? (**Flat**, held high.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

3.3 二 — two bars, and neither is decoration

Draw the character for one. Now guess what two looks like before you read on.

Script — you were right



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 二.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–2 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 二 is written, stroke by stroke

二

Two strokes, both horizontal, and the order is the one this book has repeated since the person radical: **top before bottom.**

But look properly, because they are **not the same length**:

- the **upper** bar is the **shorter** one
- the **lower** bar is the **longer** one

That is not decoration. A character occupies a square, and two identical bars floating in one look like an accident. The widening bottom gives the block a base to sit on. You will meet the same instinct everywhere: the last

horizontal tends to be the widest, because it is the one holding everything up.

Write it: **short bar. Lift. Long bar beneath.**

Your turn

- *Write it:* 二 — short bar on top, then the long one below

Before you move on

Two strokes for two. Which goes first? (The **top**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

3.4 二 — two, and a syllable you have met before

Write it: the shape — two bars, short over long

Count the strokes and say what number you expect it to be.

The sounds and tones in this word

二 *èr* means **two**. Two strokes, and it means two — the pattern holds. **èr** is **fourth tone**, the last of the four you had not used in a real word. Fourth tone **falls**, sharply and from a height, the way an English speaker says a short firm *"No."* Drop it, do not trail it. *Twice through.* Now hold **èr** next to a piece you already know:

尔 *ěr* — the sound-component inside 你

二 *èr* — the number two

Same syllable. Different tone. Completely unrelated characters. One dips; one falls. Nothing else separates them. You met this idea once already, when 好 *hǎo* "good" turned into 好 *hào* "fond of" on a change of pitch alone. That was one character with two readings; this is two characters colliding in sound. Both are the same lesson: **in Mandarin the pitch is not decoration on the word. It is part of the word.**

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

二 *èr* is inherited from Middle Chinese *nyijH*, "two" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **èr** — falling, dropped firmly
- **ěr**, then **èr** — dip, then fall. Feel the difference in your throat.
- **yī, èr** — flat, then down

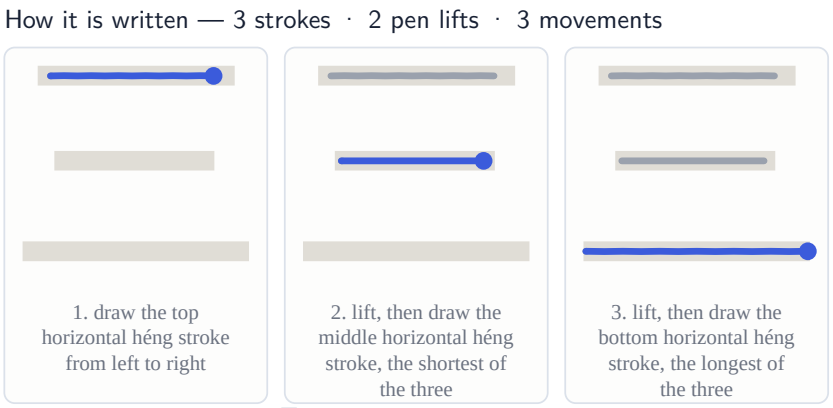
Before you move on

What separates *ěr* from *èr*? (**Only the tone** — and they are different characters entirely.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

3.5 三 — three bars, and the pattern's last stand

One bar. Two bars. Say what comes next out loud before you look.

Script — the pattern holds one last time



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 三.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 三 is written, stroke by stroke

三

Three strokes. Top, then middle, then bottom — the same rule, a third time.

The lengths are not a simple ladder:

- the **top** bar is medium
- the **middle** bar is the **shortest** of the three
- the **bottom** bar is by far the **longest**

Pinching the middle and widening the base keeps 三 from reading as three identical lines you would have to stop and count. Your eye takes it in whole. That is the difference between a **character** and a **tally** — and the reason the next one cannot be four bars.

Write it: **top, lift, middle, lift, bottom.** Two pen lifts.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 三 — top, middle short, bottom long
- *Read it:* 一 二 三 — point at each and count its strokes

Before you move on

Imagine four bars stacked in a square. Could you read it, or would you have to **count** it? (Count it — which is why the next character is not four bars.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

3.6 三 — three, and the end of the easy road

Write it: the three bars — middle short, bottom long

The sounds and tones in this word

三 *sān* means **three**. Three strokes, three — for the third and last time.
sān is **first tone**, the flat high one you met on *yī*. Hold it level. The *a* is open, the *n* light at the end. *Twice through.*
So of your first three numbers, two sit flat and one falls:

yī flat, **èr** falling, **sān** flat

Say the run. It goes *level, down, level*, and that shape is the first thing a listener recognises — before any of the individual words.

Why it's said this way

Three characters in, one stroke per unit, a system so regular it barely needs teaching. **It stops here**, and you should know why before it happens.
Every counting system humans have built hits the same wall in the same place. Roman numerals go I, II, III and then break to IV, because stacked marks stop being readable at about three. This one breaks for exactly the same reason.
You are being told now so that the next character feels like a solved problem rather than a broken promise.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

三 *sān* is inherited from Middle Chinese *sam*, "three" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The final *m* has since become *n*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **yī, èr, sān** — level, down, level
- *Read it:* 一 二 三 — say each as you point at it

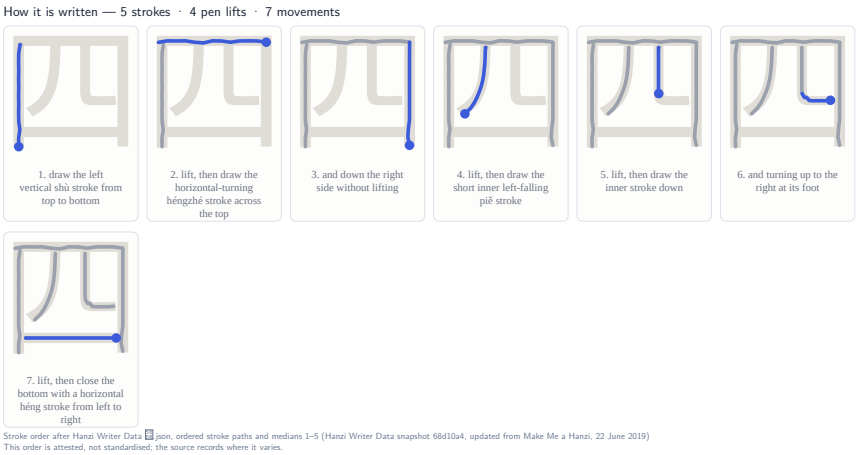
Before you move on

Three characters, three stroke counts, nothing memorised. That ends now.
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

3.7 四 — a box, and the rule that governs every box

Draw one, two and three. You were told this is where it stops.

Script — five strokes, for four



How 四 is written, stroke by stroke

四

Five strokes, for the number four. The trick is gone, exactly as promised.

四 is a **box with two things inside it**, and every box obeys one rule: **close the bottom LAST.** Walls, then contents, then shut the door.

In order:

1. the **left vertical**, top to bottom
2. the **top and right side in one turning stroke** — across, then down without lifting the pen at the corner
3. the short **inner left-falling** stroke
4. the **inner stroke that turns up** at its foot
5. the **bottom bar**, closing the box — **last**

Two strokes of wall, two of filling, one to shut the door. Four pen lifts.

Notice that the corner in step 2 is **one stroke, not two.** A horizontal that turns and runs downward without the pen leaving the paper is a single unit — *héngzhé*, "horizontal-turn". Miscounting it is the commonest way a beginner's stroke count goes wrong.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 四 — walls, then the two inner strokes, then the bottom last

Before you move on

Is the turning corner one stroke or two? (**One** — *héngzhé*.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

3.8 四 — four, borrowed for its sound

Write it: the box — walls, contents, bottom last

Count the strokes: five, for the number four.

The sounds and tones in this word

四 *sì* means **four**, and the shape has nothing to do with fourness. 四 is not a picture of four things. It is a shape that already meant something else, **borrowed for its sound** — the same move you met in 尔, a piece carried for how it sounds rather than what it means. The

borrowing won outright: nobody reads 四 as anything but four now. **sì** is **fourth tone**, falling, like *èr*. The vowel is not the *ee* of "see": after *s*, pinyin *i* is a tight buzz in the same position as the *s* itself. Say *sss*, then voice it without moving your tongue. *Twice through.*

Why it's said this way

A reason to get that tone right, and it is a real one:

sì (falling) — four

sǐ (dipping) — die

Separated **by pitch alone** — the third time this chapter has shown you that tone is part of a Mandarin word's identity, not an accent on it. Not a curiosity, either: it is why many buildings in China number floors 1, 2, 3, 5, skipping four the way some Western buildings skip thirteen.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

四 *sì* is inherited from Middle Chinese *sijH*, "four" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The sound-borrowing above is the history of the character: the word came first, and a shape was borrowed to write it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **sì** — falling, firm
- *Read it:* 一 二 三 四 — in order, then out of order

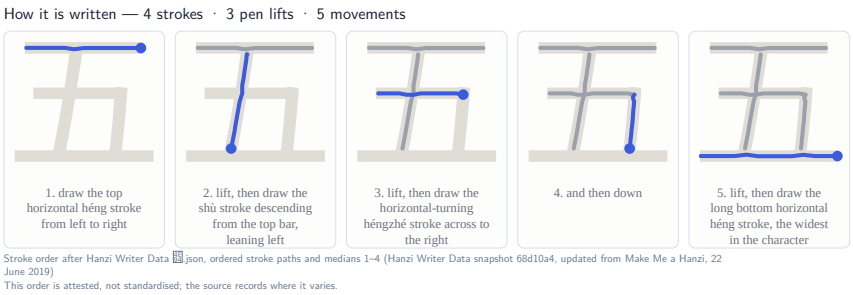
Before you move on

Four is the first number here you could not work out. What replaced the trick? (**A shape borrowed for its sound**, built to a rule.) Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

3.9 五 — count the strokes and be wrong

Guess, out loud, how many strokes the character for five will have.

Script — four, for five



How 五 is written, stroke by stroke

五

Four strokes. For five.

If you guessed five, good — that guess is the point. The trick that carried you through the first three is not merely retired, it now actively misleads.

The four strokes, in order:

1. the **top horizontal**, left to right
2. the **descending stroke**, from the top bar down, leaning slightly left
3. the **turning stroke** — across to the right, then down
4. the **bottom horizontal**, the widest in the character, closing it

You already know why the last is widest: it is the base, the same instinct as the long bottom bar of 二 and 三. Three pen lifts.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 五 — top bar, descender, turn, then the wide base
- *Read it:* 一 二 三 四 五 — name each shape without saying the numbers yet

Before you move on

Which stroke is widest, and why? (The **bottom** — it is the base.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

3.10 五 — five, and the run is complete

Write it: the shape — four strokes, for five

The sounds and tones in this word

五 *wǔ* means **five**.
wǔ is **third tone**, the low dipping one you have had since *nǐ*. Keep it low and let it creak; do not push it back up. *Twice through.*
You already own two words on this tone:

你 *nǐ*, 好 *hǎo*, 五 *wǔ*

All three dip. Say them in a row: the pitch should not change shape once, only the mouth around it.
One spelling note while you are here. In *wǔ* there is no consonant hiding under that **w**: the *w* **is** the *u*, written that way because pinyin does not begin a syllable with a bare *u*. Round your lips and voice it.

What you've built — one to five

You can now count:

一 二 三 四 五

yī, èr, sān, sì, wǔ

Say it as one run, not five separate words. The tone shape is **level, down, level, down, dip**, and that rhythm is what a listener hears first.
Five characters, and three ways one can come to you: two you derived, one was borrowed for its sound, and two you simply learned. That mix is Chinese writing in miniature, and you have now met all of it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

五 *wǔ* is inherited from Middle Chinese *nguX*, "five", whose *ng* Mandarin has lost (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). It is usually compared with Tibetan *lnga*, a likely Sino-Tibetan cognate.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **nǐ**, **hǎo**, **wǔ** — three dips, one shape
- **yī èr sān sì wǔ** — one run, at speed

Before you move on

Which tone do *nǐ*, *hǎo* and *wǔ* share? (The **third** — low and dipping.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

3.11 Practice — read the numbers off a wall

Count to five aloud, in order, without looking. Then do it again with your eyes on the characters:

一 二 三 四 五

Script — the same five, shuffled

Counting in order is slightly dishonest: the sequence carries you, and you can recite *yī èr sān* without reading anything.

So here they are shuffled. Name each before moving on, without letting your eye run back to the row above:

四 一 五 二 三

三 五 一 四 二

If one of them made you pause, it will be 四 or 五 — the two you could not derive. That is expected, and it tells you exactly which two to drill.

Why it's said this way

Not a party trick. A lift panel, a floor directory, a bus number, a market price — all use these characters **on their own**, with no sentence around them. That is why five are already useful; you are not waiting on grammar:

> **You see:** 三
>
> **You say:** *sān* — third floor.

And when the panel reads

> 一 二 三 五

with no 四 between three and five, you know why, and you are not confused by it.

The exchange

Two voices, using only what this book has given you:

> **A:** 你好 — *ní hǎo* (the sandhi tone, as always)
>
> **B:** 你好 — *ní hǎo*
>
> **A:** [pointing at a panel] 五 — *wǔ*
>
> **B:** 五 — *wǔ*

Small, and entirely real: repeating a floor number back is what people do in a lift, in any language.

Your turn

- *Read it:* 四 一 五 二 三 — cover the row above first
- *Say it:* **yī èr sān sì wǔ** — one run, level, down, level, down, dip
- *Write it:* 五 — top bar, descender, turn, wide base

What you've built this chapter

Five characters, and three different ways a character can come to you:

- 一 二 三 — transparent. The strokes *are* the number.
- 四 — borrowed for its sound, and built on a box whose rule you can reuse.
- 五 — plain. Four strokes for five, learned as a shape.

That spread is not an accident of this chapter. It is the whole writing system in small: a little of it can be reasoned out, more of it is borrowed sound, and the rest is simply known. You have now met all three, on characters short enough that none of them hurt.

Before you move on

You can read the five characters cold, in any order, with no sentence around them. A panel reads 一 二 三 五 — which number is missing, and why? (四, because *sì* sits one tone from *sǐ*.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 4

One Box, Two Characters, and the First Thing You Can Refuse

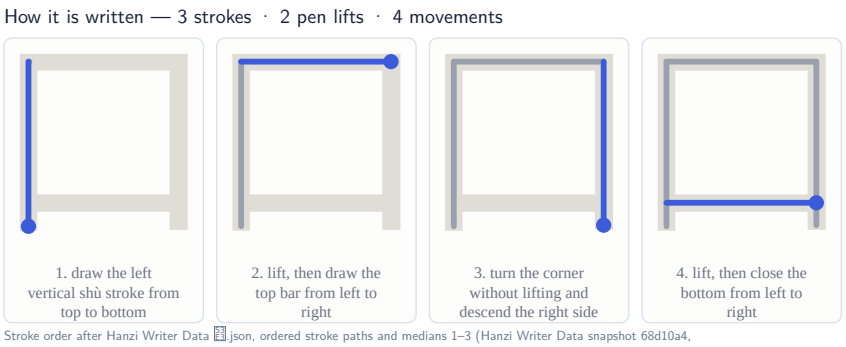
Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** none of the 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write 口 and 日 – the second being the first with one bar added – and I can disagree in Mandarin by putting 不 in front of a word I already know, because Mandarin has no standalone word for no.
>
> *The first exchange in the book that contains a disagreement – a greeting, a question, and a refusal built by negating a word the reader has had since the opening lesson.*

4.1 口 — the box, on its own

Write 四. Walls, then the two inner strokes, then the bottom last.

Script — the shape



How 口 is written, stroke by stroke

口

Your hand can already write this. Three strokes, in exactly the order you learned inside 四, and the rule from there is the whole instruction:

1. the **left vertical**, top to bottom
2. the **top and right side in one turning stroke** — the *héngzhé*, across then down without lifting
3. the **bottom bar**, closing it — **last**

Three strokes, two pen lifts. Walls, then the door.

One honest note, because it will save you trouble later. The enclosing frame around 四 and this character are **not the same piece**, even though they are written identically. Chinese has a separate enclosure component that does the surrounding, and 口 is a character in its own right. What transfers here is the hand movement, not the identity — and the hand movement is most of the work.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 口 — left wall, turning stroke, bottom last
- 四, then 口 — the same movement, two different pieces

Before you move on

How many strokes? (**Three** — the turning corner counts as one.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

4.2 口 — mouth, and a piece you will meet everywhere

Draw the box. Three strokes, bottom last.

The sounds and tones in this word

口 *kǒu* means **mouth**.
Look at it again now that it means something. **It is an open mouth, seen from the front** — squared off, the way every Chinese character is squared off to fit its block, but a picture all the same. The oldest forms are rounder and even more obviously a mouth.
kǒu is **third tone**, the low dipping one you have had since *nǐ*. Keep it low. *Twice through.*

Why it's said this way

You have already met pieces that live inside other characters — 女 and 子 sit inside 好. 口 is the commonest of them all. When you see it as a **small element in a corner** of a bigger character, it very often says the word has something to do with the **mouth**: speaking, eating, calling, tasting.
The size matters. A full-height frame around a whole character is a different piece doing a different job; the mouth hint is for the small one tucked into a corner.
That is worth more than the word itself. You are not going to memorise five thousand characters as pictures; you are going to learn a few hundred pieces and read the rest as combinations. 口 is one of the commonest pieces there is.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

口 *kǒu* is inherited from Middle Chinese *khuwX*, "mouth" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The open-mouth picture is the history of

the character; the word is the inherited one.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **kǒu** — low and dipping
- *Write it:* 口 — and say what it is a picture of

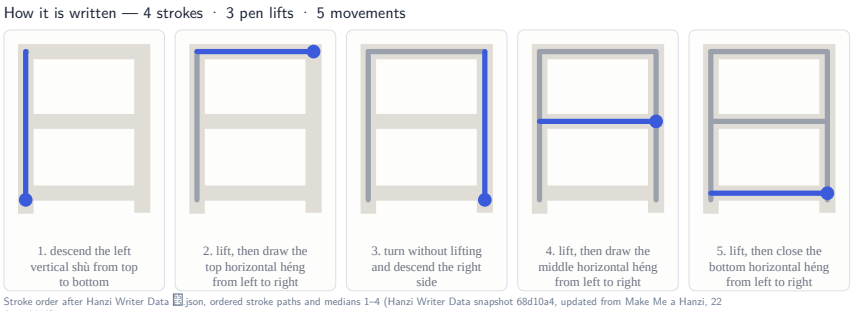
Before you move on

If you meet this box inside a bigger character, what does it usually hint at? (Something to do with the **mouth**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

4.3 日 — one bar inside the box

Draw the box. Now hold it in your head; you are about to fill it.

Script — the shape



How 日 *is written, stroke by stroke*

日

The same box, with one horizontal bar across the middle. That is the entire difference, and it buys you a second character.

Four strokes, and the order has one thing worth getting right:

1. the **left vertical**

2. the **top and right side**, one turning stroke
3. the **middle bar**
4. the **bottom bar**, closing it — still last

The middle bar goes in before the bottom. Fill the box, then shut it. That is the same instinct as the box rule itself, applied one level in: you never close a space you still have to write inside.

Three pen lifts. If your box was comfortable, this cost you one line.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 口, then 日 — the same four movements plus one
- 日 — and check that the middle bar went in before the bottom

Before you move on

How many strokes separate this character from the box? (**One**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

4.4 日 — the sun, and the day it measures

Write it: the box, then the box with a bar

Two characters, one shape.

The sounds and tones in this word

日 *rì* means **sun** — and also **day**.
The picture is the sun: a disc with a mark in the middle. Squared off, like everything else, but that is what the bar is doing there. The oldest forms are a circle with a dot.
rì is **fourth tone**, falling. The *r* is not an English *r* and not a Spanish one either: start where your tongue sits for the *s* in English *measure*, then **curl the tip back** a little. Let the vowel be short and tight.
Twice through:

Why it's said this way

Sun and **day** in the same word is not a Chinese quirk. It is what happens in language after language, because the sun is how a day was counted before anybody had a clock. English does the same thing from the other end: we say *the sun rose* and *three days later*, and nobody finds it strange that a *day* is both the light and the span.
So this is one of the rare characters where you get two meanings and have to learn neither: they are the same idea, and the context tells you which.
Like 口, this one turns up **inside** other characters, and when it does it is almost always about the sun, light, or time.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

日 *rì* is inherited from Middle Chinese *nyit*, "sun, day" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). It is usually compared with Tibetan *nyi ma*, "sun", a likely Sino-Tibetan cognate.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **rì** — falling, and the *r* of *measure*
- *Write it:* 日 — and say both of its meanings

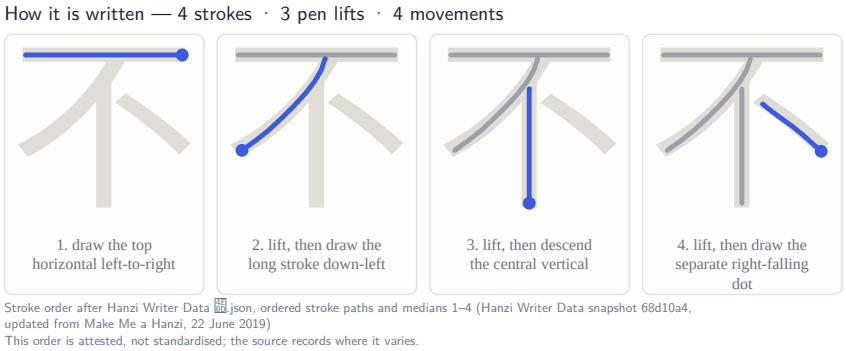
Before you move on

If you meet this shape inside a bigger character, what is it hinting at? (**Sun, light or time**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

4.5 不 — four strokes, all of them separate

Write 日. Middle bar before the bottom.

Script — the shape



How 不 is written, stroke by stroke

不

Four strokes, in this order:

1. a **top horizontal**, left to right
2. lift, then a **long stroke from the upper centre down to the left**
3. lift, then the **central vertical**, straight down
4. lift, then a **short right-falling dot**

Three pen lifts, and every stroke stands alone. Nothing joins here. That is unusual enough to be worth saying plainly: the boxes you have just written were one continuous movement in places, and this is the opposite — four deliberate, separate marks under a single roof.

The commonest beginner's version runs the second and third strokes together into a corner. They are not a corner. Lift.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 不 — top bar, the long left-falling stroke, the vertical, the dot
- it again, counting the lifts aloud. There should be three.

Before you move on

Do the second and third strokes meet in a corner? (**No** — lift between them.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

4.6 不 — how Mandarin says no

Write it: 不, counting three lifts

Then say **hǎo** — good.

The sounds and tones in this word

不 *bù* means **not**.
bù is **fourth tone**, falling — the same firm drop you learned on *èr* and *sì*. *Twice through.*

Grammar Lens: there is no word for "no"

Here is something that surprises nearly every learner, and it is better met now than discovered later.
Mandarin has no single word meaning "no."
English has one. So does French, Spanish, Russian. Mandarin does not. What it has instead is 不, which goes in front of a word and turns it around:

好 *hǎo* — good

不好 *bù hǎo* — not good

So when someone asks you a yes-or-no question in Mandarin, you do not answer with a word for "no". **You answer by negating the thing they asked about.** Ask whether something is 好, and "no" comes back as 不好.
This sounds like extra work and is actually less: you already know 好, so you already know how to refuse it, and the same holds for every word you have so far.
One word will break the pattern later — Mandarin has a second negator for *having*, and you will meet it with the word it belongs to. Everything in this book up to now takes 不.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不 *bù* is inherited from Middle Chinese, and it is already a negator in the oldest Chinese writing. The Guangyun lists it as *pjuw* and as *pjut*, both "not" (in Baxter's transcription); Mandarin *bù* continues *pjut*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **bù** — falling, firm
- *Say it:* **hǎo**, then **bù hǎo** — good, then not good
- *Write it:* 不好

Before you move on

You have known 好 since the first lesson. How much did its opposite cost you? (**One character**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

4.7 Practice — one box, two characters, and a refusal

Write it: 口, then 日 — one line apart

The exchange

Two voices, using only what you have:

A: 你好

ní hǎo

B: 你好

ní hǎo

A: 好

hǎo — good?

B: 不好

bù hǎo — not good.

Small, and it is the first time in this book you have been able to **disagree**. Up to now every exchange has been agreement: a greeting answered by the same greeting, a number read back. This one has a no in it.

What you've built this chapter

Three characters, and not one of them cost what it looks like it cost:

- 口 *kǒu*, mouth — you already knew the shape; it is the box from the number four, standing on its own
- 日 *rì*, sun and day — the same box with one bar added
- 不 *bù*, not — four separate strokes, and it turns every word you own into its opposite

That last one is the largest thing in the chapter. **不 does not add one word to your vocabulary; it doubles what you already have.** Everything you have learned to say so far, you have now learned to refuse.
And the two boxes are a down payment of a different kind. 口 and 日 both turn up **inside** other characters — mouth for speaking and eating, sun for light and time — so the next character that contains one will already be half read.

Your turn

- *Read it:* 口 日 不 — name each one, then say what it means
- *Write it:* 日 — and check the middle bar went in before the bottom
- *Say it:* **hǎo**, then **bù hǎo**

Before you move on

Which two of this chapter's characters share a shape? (口 and 日.)
Back in the lift: a voice calls *sì*, then *èr*. Say each floor back, and say which of the two some panels leave out. (*Sì*, *èr* — and 四, four, is the one a panel may skip.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 5

Yes, No, and a Tone That Moves

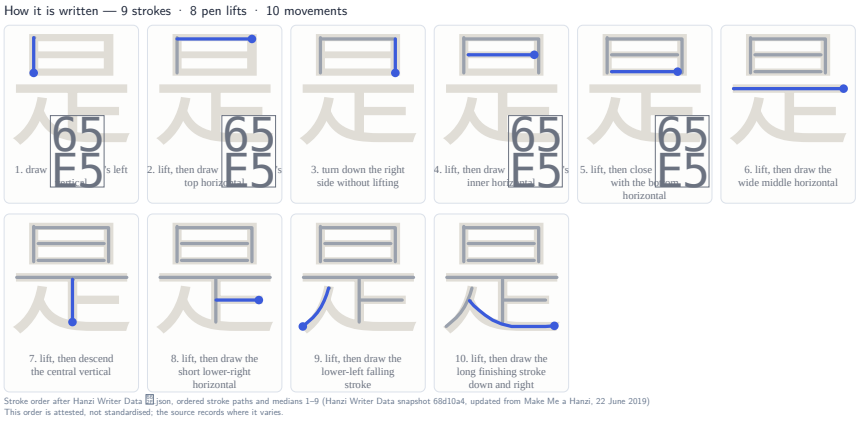
Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write 是 by finishing 日 before the body underneath, answer a yes-or-no question either way by keeping or negating the word I was asked about, and apply the rule that 不 rises before a falling tone even though the writing never shows it.
>
> *The first exchange in which the reader can answer either way – 是 for yes, 不是 for no – and hear the negator's pitch rise on a page that records no such thing.*

5.1 是 — finish the sun, then build under it

Write 日. Four strokes, middle bar before the bottom.

Script — the shape



How 是 *is written, stroke by stroke*

是

Nine strokes. That is more than double anything you have written, and it is the point at which counting strokes stops being useful and structure takes over.

Here is the structure, and it makes the character easy: **是 is 日 sitting on top of a body.** You have written the top already.

1-4. **日, complete.** Left vertical; top and right in one turning stroke; the middle bar; the bottom bar closing it. Exactly as you learned it.

Then, underneath:

1. a **wide horizontal**, wider than the 日 above it
2. a **central vertical** coming down
3. a **short horizontal** at the lower right
4. a **falling stroke** to the lower left
5. a **long finishing stroke** down to the right

Finish 日 before you begin the body. This is the same instinct as the box rule and the middle bar: complete an enclosed unit before moving on. Chinese stroke order is a small number of habits applied over and over, and you now have three of them.

Eight pen lifts. Take it slowly; nobody writes this quickly at first.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 日 on its own, then 是 — and notice the first four strokes are identical
- 是 again, saying "sun first" before you start

Before you move on

How many of the nine strokes did you already know? (**Four**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

5.2 是 — "is", and the nearest thing to "yes"

Write it: 是 — sun first, then the body

The sounds and tones in this word

是 *shì* means **is** — am, is, are, all one word with no changes for person or number.
shì is **fourth tone**, falling. The initial is the same retroflex position you met on *rì*: tongue tip curled back, and this time unvoiced — closer to the *sh* of English *shirt* than to *s*. *Twice through.*

Grammar Lens: yes by echo

You already know that Mandarin has no single word for **no** — you negate the word you were asked about. The other half of that rule is now available to you:
Mandarin has no single word for "yes" either. You echo the word back.
Asked whether something 是, you answer 是. That is the yes. It is not a separate word meaning agreement; it is the word you were asked about, returned.
It is not the *only* way Mandarin says yes — spoken Mandarin has other affirmatives you will meet in time. It is the one that follows from what you already know, and the one that works whenever the question hands you a word to give back.
Neither half of the pair is the word an English speaker goes looking for.

This is worth holding onto, because it is the shape of a great many Mandarin answers: **the reply is the question's own word, kept or turned.** You have the keeping half now; the turning half is the next lesson, and you already own the character it needs.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

是 *shì* is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). In the oldest texts it meant "this"; its use as "to be" came later, and Unihan still lists both senses.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **shì** — falling, tongue curled back
- *Say it:* **shì** as an answer meaning "yes"
- *Write it:* 是

Before you move on

What is the yes, asked about 是? (是 — the same word, returned.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

5.3 不是 — "is not", and the second tone that moves

Say **shì**. Then say **bù**. Both fall.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不是

Nothing new on the page: 不 in front of 是, exactly the rule you already have. It means **is not**.
But say the two words you just warmed up with, one after the other, and something is wrong. **bù** falls. **shì** falls. Two sharp drops in a row, back to back, and your mouth does not want to make them.
Both words are inherited from Middle Chinese: *pjut*, "not", and *dzyeX*, "this, to be" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Why it's said this way

Mandarin does not make you do it. **不 changes its own tone rather than collide.**

written: 不是 — *bù* + *shì*

spoken: **bú shì** — *bú* **rises**

不 becomes second tone, rising, whenever a fourth tone follows it. Before anything else it stays *bù*, falling — which is why 不好 was *bù hǎo*, unchanged, with 好 in the third tone.
You have met this exact machinery once before. When two third tones met in 你好, the first one moved and became rising, so *nǐ hǎo* came out as *ní hǎo*. Same problem, same kind of solution: **when two tones would clash, the first one gives way, and the spelling never records it.**
That is the **second** rule of this kind you have been taught in full, and both share one warning: **the page will not tell you.** You were also warned about a third, on 一, which shifts its own tone in front of certain syllables — that one is still waiting, and it will arrive with the words that need it. 不是 is written with the falling-tone 不 every time. The change lives in the mouth, and you have to carry it yourself.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **bù**, then **shì**, deliberately clashing. Hear why it is awkward.
- **bú shì** — the first one rising now
- **bù hǎo**, then **bú shì** — falling, then rising, and say why

Before you move on

Does the writing change when the tone does? (**No** — 不是 is written the same way every time.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

5.4 Practice — answering either way

Write it: 是 — sun first, then the body underneath

The exchange

Two voices, and for the first time the second one has a real choice:

A: 你好

ní hǎo

B: 你好

ní hǎo

A: 是

shì — is it?

B: 是

shì — yes.

And the same exchange, refused:

A: 是

shì

B: 不是

bú shì — no.

Say the last line twice and listen to the first syllable. It **rises**. Written down, it falls. That gap between the page and the mouth is the whole lesson.

What you've built this chapter

One character, and with it both answers.
是 is nine strokes, the longest thing you have written — but four of them were 日, finished before the body began, and that is why it was manageable. The habit of completing an enclosed piece before moving

on has now carried you through a box, a box with a bar, and a nine-stroke character built on top of one.
And the pair is closed. Mandarin gives you neither a word for yes nor a word for no; it gives you one word and two things to do with it. 是 keeps it. 不是 turns it. Every yes-or-no answer you learn from here will work the same way.
The tone rule is the part to carry away, because nothing on the page will remind you: 不 **rises before a falling tone.** That is the second such rule taught in full, after the one on 你好, and a third — on 一 — has been flagged and not yet taught. Every one of them is invisible in the writing.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **shì**, then **bú shì** — yes, then no
- *Say it:* **bù hǎo**, then **bú shì** — and say which one moved, and why
- *Write it:* 是, then 不是

Before you move on

Do either of the rules you have been taught show up in the writing? (**Neither**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 6

See You Again

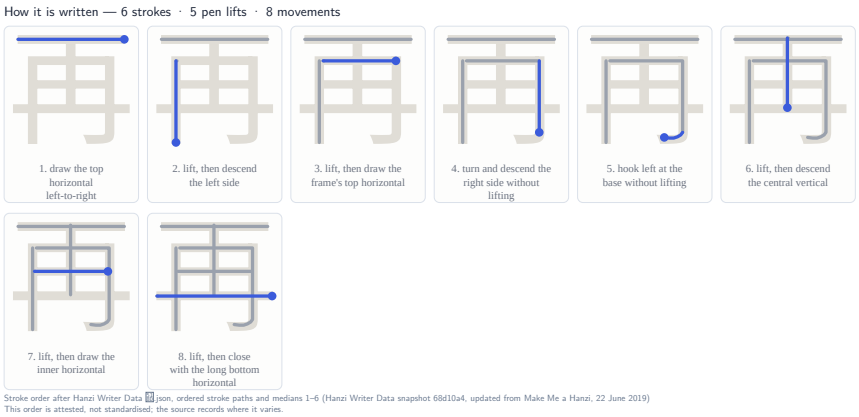
Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write 再 and 见, say goodbye with 再见, read the word literally as "see again" because its two pieces genuinely add up, and name which expressions I know are spoken differently from how they are written.
>
> *The first exchange in the track that opens, turns and closes – greeting, an answer either way, and a parting – with every line built from characters the reader has written rather than a phrase memorised whole.*

6.1 再 — a bar, a frame, and a line that closes it

Write 是. Nine strokes, and the sun on top finished first.

Script — the shape



How 再 *is written, stroke by stroke*

再

Six strokes. Fewer than the last one, and the structure is easier to see: a horizontal bar across the top, a frame hanging underneath it, and a long horizontal closing the whole thing at the bottom.

1. the **top horizontal**, left to right
2. the **left side**, coming straight down
3. the **frame**: start again at the upper left, cross to the right, **turn down** the right side, and **hook left** at the base — all without lifting
4. the **central vertical**, down through the middle
5. the **inner horizontal**, left to right
6. the **long bottom horizontal**, left to right, wider than everything above it

Five pen lifts.

Stroke 3 is the one to watch. It is a **single stroke that changes direction twice** — across, down, then a hook to the left. You have met most of it before: the outer wall of a box is always one turning stroke, never two or three. Compare it with the frame you drew in 日 — the same across-and-down turn, with a hook added at the end.

And the closing bar is last. **The box is not sealed until the end** — the same rule that made you draw the middle bar of 日 before its bottom bar. Chinese stroke order keeps re-using a small set of habits, and this is one you now know well enough to expect.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 再 — bar, left side, then the turning frame in one movement
- *Write it:* 再 again, and count the lifts. There are five.
- *Say it:* **zài** — falling, from high to low

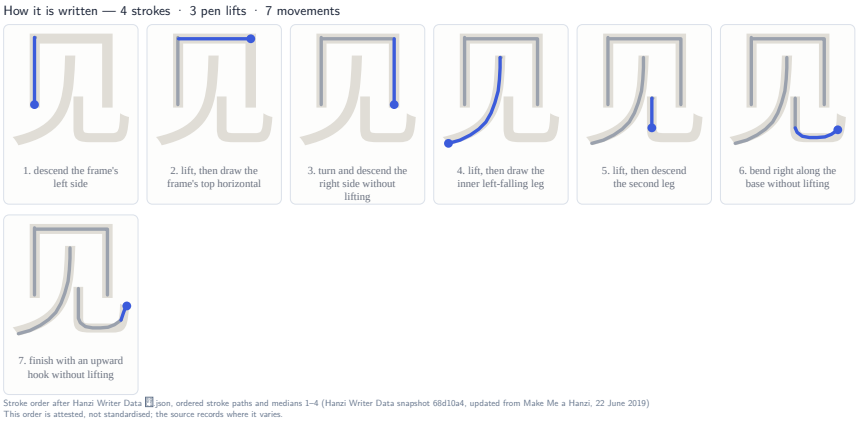
Before you move on

Which stroke of 再 is drawn last? (**The long bottom bar**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

6.2 见 — an eye on two legs

Write 人. Two strokes, left before right, a figure on two legs.

Script — the shape



How 见 *is written, stroke by stroke*

见

Four strokes, and after the last two characters that will feel like a rest. It is built in two parts, top and bottom:

- on top, a **frame** — a narrow box, which the traditional reading takes to be an **eye**
- underneath, **two legs**, written 儿 — which is what 人 becomes when it has to stand underneath something

The legs have changed a little in this position. The left one still falls away to the lower left exactly as it did. The right one no longer just presses down: it descends, **bends right along the base, and finishes with a hook upward**. That is what a leg does when it has to carry a frame above it.

The order:

1. the frame's **left side**, coming down
2. the frame's **top**, turning down the **right side** — one stroke, no lift, and this one is exactly the turn you drew in 日, hook and all absent
3. the **left leg**, falling to the lower left
4. the **right leg**: down, bend right, hook up — one stroke, no lift

Three pen lifts. Two of the four strokes turn, and neither of them is allowed to be broken into pieces.

A frame over a person, and the word means "to see." That is a memory hook, not a proof — but it is the kind of hook this book has been giving you in place of a shared ancestor with English, and this one is unusually easy to hold.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 人, then 见 — and find the legs in the second one
- *Write it:* 见, stopping after stroke 2 to check the frame is closed on three sides
- *Say it:* **jiàn** — falling

Before you move on

How does the last stroke finish? (**With a hook, upward**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

6.3 再见 — the word that says what it means

Write it: 再, then 见 — six strokes, then four

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

再见

再见 *zàijiàn* — **goodbye**. Two characters, one word, and you can already write both of them.
Now the meanings, which have been held back until you had the shapes:

- 再 *zài* means **again**
- 见 *jiàn* means **see**

So the word is **"see again."** That is no mnemonic: it is what the two characters say, and what the word means.
Every earlier component gave you a *hook* — 亻 at the left of 你, 女 beside 子 in 好 — labelled a memory aid rather than history. **Here the parts add up.** Chinese does this often. Start expecting it.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *tsojH*, "a second time", and *kenH*, "see" (Guangyun).

The sounds and tones in this word

Both syllables are **fourth tone**. Both fall.
Say it slowly: *zài* falls, then *jiàn* falls. Two separate drops. The common mistake is to run them into one long slide. Reset your pitch upward between them. *Twice through.*
And no *rule* moves. Neither of the two tone rules you have been taught applies to two fourth tones, so **再见 is said with the tones it is written with.** A native speaker does clip that first fall a little short

— but that is a shading of the same tone, not a different one, and neither the characters nor the pinyin change. Which is the point: the shadings live in the mouth.

Why it's said this way

If you know any German: *auf Wiedersehen* is "on seeing again" — the same two pieces, in the same order. A coincidence of thinking, not of ancestry; **Chinese and German share no common ancestor.** But parting by promising to meet again is an idea many languages reach for on their own, and that makes 再见 far easier to hold than a shape memorised cold.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **zàijiàn** — two falls, resetting the pitch between them
- *Read it:* 再见 — give its literal reading before its translation

Before you move on

Does either tone move in 再见? (**No — both fall, and nothing changes**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

6.4 Practice — a conversation that ends

Say **zàijiàn**. Two falls, with the pitch reset between them.

The exchange

Everything below is a character you have written yourself. *Read it:* the exchange straight through

A: 你好

ní hǎo — hello.

B: 你好

ní hǎo — hello.

A: 是

shì — is it?

B: 不是

bú shì — no.

A: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

B: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

That is a conversation with a beginning, a middle and an end. It is short, and it is real: two people meet, one asks something, the other declines it, and both leave properly. **Nothing in it is a phrase you memorised whole.** You built every line from characters and rules.

What you've built — and what stays invisible

Read it: the exchange out loud once more, and count the places where your mouth does something the page does not record

- 你好 is written with two low dipping tones and spoken *ní hǎo* — the first one rises.
- 不是 is written with a falling 不 and spoken *bú shì* — the 不 rises.
- 再见 is written with two falls and spoken with two falls. No rule moves.

Two out of three. That ratio is not a fluke, and it is the single most useful thing to know about reading Mandarin aloud: **the writing records the words, not the way the words meet each other.** From here on, whenever two pieces sit side by side, ask what happens between them.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts, without stopping

- *Say it:* it again, taking B's side, and answer 是 instead of 不是
- *Write it:* 再见 — six strokes, then four

Before you move on

In this exchange, how many of the three expressions are spoken exactly as written? (**One** — 再见.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 7

Good Morning, and a Rule That Declines to Fire

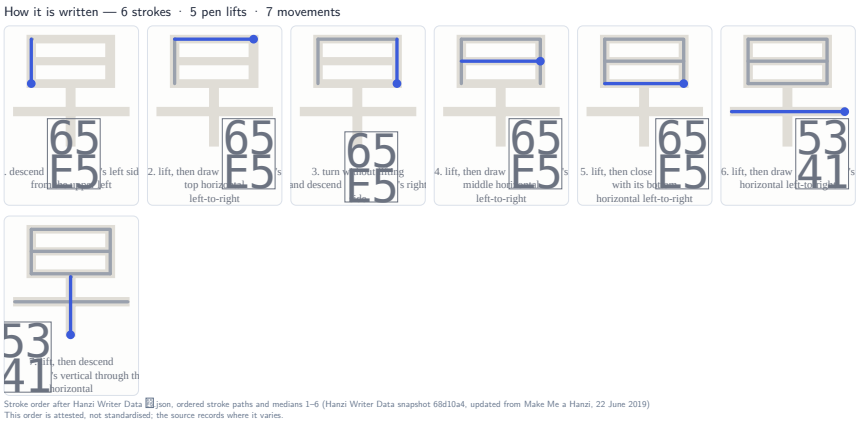
Modes: **voice** (3) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write 早 and 上, greet someone with 早上好, hear a neutral-tone syllable as the absence of a tone mark rather than a mistake, and say why the third-tone rule changes 你好 but leaves 早上好 alone.
>
> *The first exchange where the reader chooses between two correct greetings rather than reciting the only one available – and the first place all three tone behaviours in the track line up side by side, one moving and two declining to.*

7.1 早 — sun on top, one more time

Write 日. Four strokes. Middle bar before the bottom bar.

Script — the shape



How 早 is written, stroke by stroke

早

Six strokes, and you can already guess how it starts.

早 is 日 on top of 十. You have written the sun before. The piece underneath is 十, which on its own is the character for **ten** — you have not been taught it and you do not need it today. Treat it as two strokes: one across, one down through it.

1-4. **日, complete.** Left side; top and right in one turning stroke; the middle bar; the bottom bar closing it.

1. **十's horizontal**, left to right
2. **十's vertical**, coming down *through* that horizontal

Five pen lifts.

Predict the rule before you read it: does 日 get finished first? It does — the same habit that made 是 manageable, and by now it should be doing the work for you rather than the instruction.

A word about what 早 means, offered as a memory hook and labelled as one: the sun sitting above a short line is easy to read as **the sun just up over the horizon**, and 早 means **early**. That is a picture worth keeping. It is not a proof, and the honest position is that the lower piece's history is disputed.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 日, then 早 — and stop after four strokes to check the sun is closed
- *Say it:* **zǎo** — low and dipping

Before you move on

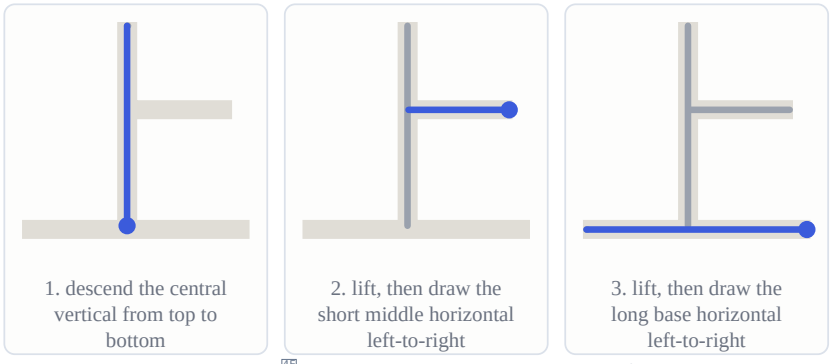
Which way does the last stroke go? (**Down, through the horizontal.**)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

7.2 上 — the same rule, read the other way

Write 早. Sun first, then the two strokes below.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 上.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 上 is written, stroke by stroke

上

Three strokes. A vertical, a short horizontal to its right, and a long horizontal underneath.

Now guess the order, and expect to be wrong:

1. the **central vertical**, from the top down
2. the **short horizontal**, left to right, starting at the vertical
3. the **long base horizontal**, left to right

Two pen lifts.

The vertical comes first, and you wrote the opposite one lesson ago. Inside 早, the two strokes of 十 went **horizontal first, then the vertical down through it**. Here the order is reversed.

The difference is what the two strokes do to each other. In 十 they **cross**, and the horizontal leads. In 上 the short bar **starts at** the vertical instead of crossing it — so there is nothing to cross, and the vertical goes first.

That is worth meeting on a three-stroke character, because it tells you something true about the system: these are **strong tendencies with conditions**, not laws. Learn the condition and you can predict the order instead of memorising it.

The other thing to notice: **short horizontal before long horizontal.** The base bar is the widest stroke and it goes last, exactly as the closing bar did in 再. When two horizontals differ in length, the long one is usually the finisher.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 上 — vertical first, even though your hand will want the short bar
- *Write it:* 上 again, and say "short, then long" as you draw the two bars
- *Say it:* **shàng** — falling

Before you move on

Which of the two horizontals is drawn last? (**The long one**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

7.3 早上 — morning, and a syllable that goes light

Say **zǎo**. Low and dipping, and hold the bottom of it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

早上

早上 *zǎoshang* — **morning**.
The parts add up again, though less tidily than 再见 did. 早 is *early*; 上 on its own means *up* or *on top*. Early-up, the early part of the day. Take that as a hook rather than a definition: what you need is that the two characters you just wrote make the word for morning.
Both halves are inherited from Middle Chinese: *tsawX*, "early, dawn", and *dzyangH*, "above" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

The sounds and tones in this word

The pinyin for this word is *zǎoshang* — and **上 has lost its tone mark.**
On its own 上 is *shàng*, fourth tone, falling — you practised it that way. Inside this word it goes **neutral**: short, light, and pitched by whatever came before it. Neutral syllables are written with **no mark at all**, and that absence is the information.
This is a fifth thing a syllable can do, alongside the four tones. It is not a tone that moves — you have met two of those — it is a syllable **giving up its tone** because it is unstressed. *Twice through.*
Careful or slow speech sometimes restores the full falling tone, *zǎoshàng*, and you will hear it. The standard reading, and the one to imitate, is the light one.
Say it: *zǎo* low and dipping, then *shang* light and quick, riding on the end. The commonest mistake is to give the second syllable a full falling tone out of habit, which makes the word sound like two words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **shàng** alone, falling — then **zǎoshang**, with the second syllable light
- **zǎoshang** twice more, and say aloud which syllable carries no tone

Before you move on

Does 上 keep its falling tone when it stands alone? (**Yes** — the light reading belongs to the word, not to the character.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

7.4 早上好 — the greeting was a pattern all along

Say **zǎoshang**. Second syllable light.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

早上好

早上好 *zǎoshang hǎo* — **good morning**.
It ends in 好 — the same character, the same word, that you met in the first greeting in this book.
That is the payoff, and it is worth being explicit about. 你好 was never a phrase to swallow whole. It is 你 *you* followed by 好 *good*, and the second half is reusable:

你 + 好 → 你好, and 早上 + 好 → 早上好

Put a person or a time in front of 好 and you have a greeting. You have not learned two greetings; you have learned a **frame** and filled it twice. Every one of the other times of day works the same way, and you will be able to build those greetings the moment you have the words for those times.
Every piece is inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsawX* "early", *dzyangH* "above" and *xawX* "good" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and Chinese put the greeting together from them.

The sounds and tones in this word

You know a rule about two third tones meeting: the first one rises, which is why 你好 is said *ní hǎo*.
早 is third tone. 好 is third tone. So does 早上好 become *záoshang hǎo*?
No — and the reason is the whole point of a rule having conditions. The rule needs the two third tones to be **next to each**

other. Here they are not: 上 sits between them. A light, toneless syllable is still a syllable, and it keeps the two dipping tones apart. So *zǎoshang hǎo*: 早 low, 上 light, 好 low and dipping. Nothing rises.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **nǐ hǎo**, then **zǎoshang hǎo** — and say which one moved
- **zǎoshang**, then **zǎoshang hǎo** — the greeting is the word plus 好

Before you move on

Why does the third-tone rule not fire in this greeting? (**The two third tones are not next to each other**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

7.5 Practice — greeting the time of day

Say **zǎoshang hǎo**. Low, light, low.

The exchange

A: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

B: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

A: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

B: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

Short, and for the first time you had a **choice** to make. 你好 would also have been correct. 早上好 is the one that fits the hour, and choosing between them is a thing a speaker does, not a thing a phrasebook does for you.

What you've built — three tones, three behaviours

Line the greetings up and every tone behaviour you have been taught is visible at once:

- 你好 — two third tones, side by side. The first **rises**: *ní hǎo*.
- 早上好 — two third tones, held apart by a light syllable. **Neither moves**.
- 再见 — two falling tones. **Neither moves.**

That middle line is the one that repays study. It is the same rule as the first line, and it does not fire, because the condition it needs is not met. **A rule you can only apply is half a rule; a rule you can also decline to apply is a whole one.**
And none of it shows on the page. Every character in all three is written exactly as it would be alone.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **nǐ hǎo**, then **zǎoshang hǎo** — and say which one moved
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 早上好, then 再见

Before you move on

Which of the three expressions above has a tone that moves? (**Only 你好.**)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 8

Saying Who You Are

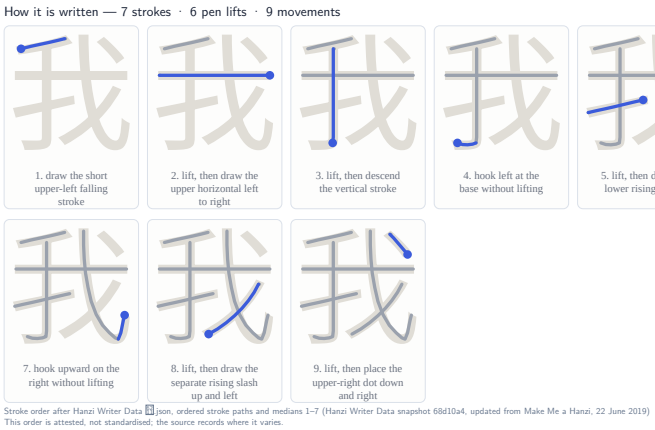
Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ↙ **pen** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write 我, 名 and 字, introduce myself with 我是 and my own name, recognise 名字 as the word for a name, and I know that Mandarin never changes a word to show what job it is doing in a sentence.
>
> *The first exchange the reader cannot finish without supplying something of their own – their name – and the first place the book names a gap it is choosing not to fill, rather than teaching a sentence no speaker would say.*

8.1 我 — seven strokes, and an honest admission

Write 是. Nine strokes, sun finished on top.

Script — the shape



How 我 is written, stroke by stroke

我

Seven strokes, and here this book owes you a straight answer.

Every character so far has had **at least one piece you already owned**: 你 is 亻 beside 尔, 是 sits on 日, 早 sits on 日. 我 **has none.** Its right side is a shape called 戈 — there it is, but naming it is all this lesson will do with it, because you have not been taught to write it. Its left side is a squeezed hand. Neither is a piece you own.

So learn it as a **route**, not as a sum. Follow the order and it holds together:

1. a short **falling stroke** at the upper left
2. the **upper horizontal**, left to right
3. the **vertical**, coming down and **hooking left** without lifting
4. the **lower rising stroke**
5. the **long curved slash** down to the right, **hooking upward** at its end
6. a separate **rising slash** up to the left
7. a **dot** at the upper right, pressed down-right

Six pen lifts.

Two of these are joined strokes that must not be broken: **stroke 3** (down, then hook) and **stroke 5** (the long slash, then hook up). Everything you have learned about turning strokes applies here — the pen changes direction, the stroke does not end.

The dot goes **last**. Small marks at the upper right are finishers, and you will see that again.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 我 slowly, twice — and keep strokes 3 and 5 unbroken
- *Write it:* 我 once more, saving the dot for last
- *Say it:* **wǒ** — low and dipping

Before you move on

Is this character built from pieces you already know? (**No** — and this book would rather say so than invent a story.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

8.2 我 — I, me, and saying who you are

Say **wǒ**. Low and dipping, and hold the bottom of it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

我 *wǒ* — **I**. And also **me**.
English uses two words there and swaps between them depending on the job: *I saw her*, *she saw me*. **Mandarin uses 我 for both**, and this is your first sight of something that will save you a great deal of work: **Mandarin never changes a word to show what job it is doing in a sentence.** No I/me swap, no case endings, no agreeing with a subject. 我 is 我 in either seat.
Mandarin does bolt small extra pieces onto words for *other* jobs, and you will meet them — but never to mark who is doing what to whom.
Now put it to work with a word you already have:

我是 *wǒ shì* — **I am**

是 is the word you learned for answering yes. Its actual job is to link two things: 我是 and then who you are. Say your own name after it and you have introduced yourself.
There is a second way to say this, built on a word you do not have yet. 我是 **is not a stand-in for it** — both are real, and this is the one you can write today.
Two third tones meet in *wǒ shì*? No — 是 is **fourth** tone. Nothing moves.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **wǒ**, then **wǒ shì** — low and dipping, then falling
- *Say it:* **wǒ shì** followed by your own name, out loud, twice
- *Write it:* 我是

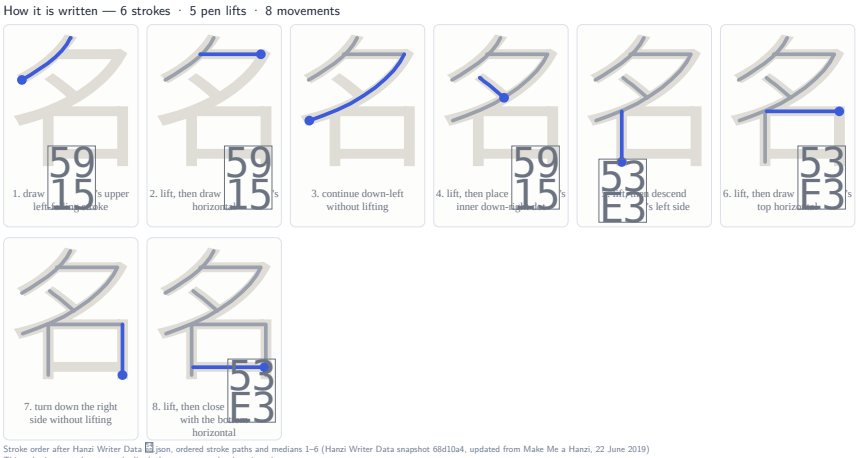
Before you move on

What does 是 do in 我是? (**It links you to whatever comes next**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

8.3 名 — a mouth with something above it

Write 口. Three strokes, and the box is not closed until the last one.

Script — the shape



How 名 is written, stroke by stroke

名

Six strokes, and three of them are 口, which you already own.

名 is 夕 sitting on top of 口. The lower half is the mouth. The upper half is 夕, a shape this book has not taught you as a character of its own — here it is a piece, and naming it is enough:

1. **夕's upper falling stroke**, down to the left
2. **夕's horizontal**, continuing **down-left without lifting** — one stroke
3. **夕's inner dot**, pressed down-right

4-6. **口, complete.** Left side; top and right in one turning stroke; the bottom bar closing it.

Five pen lifts.

Finish 夕 before you begin 口 — the same instinct as finishing 日 before the body of 是, and finishing the sun before 十 in 早. You have now met that rule often enough that it should feel like the obvious thing to do.

A hook worth having, offered as a hook: 夕 is the shape used for **evening**, and a mouth beneath it reads easily as **speaking your name in the dark, when you cannot be seen**. That is a traditional story, not proven history — but 名 does mean **name**, and the picture makes the character stick.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 口 alone, then 名 — and notice the last three strokes are identical
- *Write it:* 名 again, keeping stroke 2 unbroken
- *Say it:* **míng** — rising

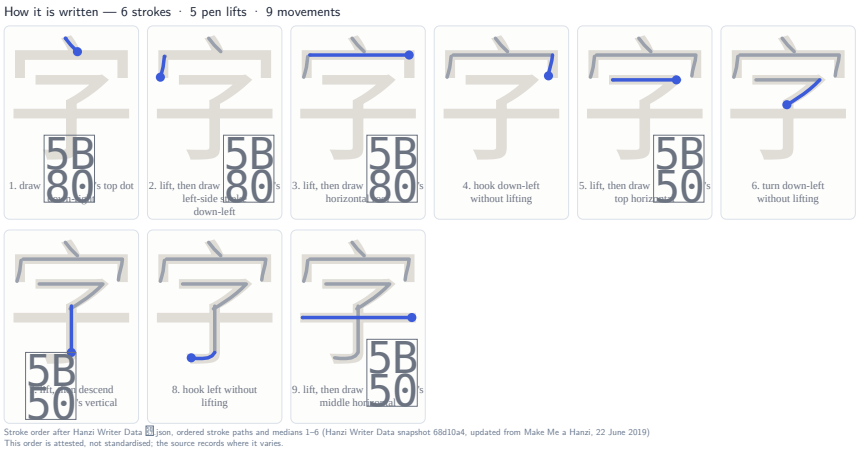
Before you move on

Which half goes first? (**The top** — as always.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

8.4 字 — a child under a roof

Write 子, the child — the piece that stands beside 女 in 好.

Script — the shape



How 字 is written, stroke by stroke

字

Six strokes, and the bottom three are 子, which you have written since the first chapter.

字 is 子 under a roof. The roof is 宀, a piece rather than a character — three strokes that make a lid:

1. **宀's top dot**, pressed down-right
2. **宀's left side**, a short stroke down-left
3. **宀's horizontal roof**, running right and **hooking down-left** at its end — one stroke

4-6. **子, complete.** Its top horizontal turning down-left; its vertical with a left hook; its middle horizontal last.

Five pen lifts.

Roof before child. A covering piece is finished before whatever sits under it, which is the same habit as 日 before the body of 是 and 夕 before 口 in 名.

And now the meaning, which is the reason this character is worth the effort. 字 *zì* means **character** — a written Chinese character. It is the word for the thing you have been learning to make since the first page of this book. The roof-and-child picture is the traditional hook: something raised and kept under shelter.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 子 alone, then 字 — the difference is a roof
- *Write it:* 字, saying "roof first" before you start
- *Say it:* **zì** — falling

Before you move on

Which goes first, the roof or the child? (**The roof**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

8.5 名字 — the word for a name

Say **zǎoshang**. Second syllable light and short.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

名字 *míngzi* — **name**.
Both halves are characters you have just written, and both mean something:

- 名 *míng* — **name**
- 字 *zì* — **character**, a written unit

So the word is **"name-character"**, and that is not a stretched hook. A Chinese personal name *is* a small number of characters, usually two or three, each chosen deliberately for what it means. The word for "name" says what a name is made of.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *mjieng*, "name", and *dziH*, "written character" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

The sounds and tones in this word

míngzi, not *míngzì*.
字 is fourth tone standing alone, and you practised it that way — but in this word it goes **neutral**, short and light, exactly as 上 did inside 早上. Second syllables do this often, and you now know the signal: **no tone mark means no tone.**
míng rises; *zi* rides on the end of it. *Twice through.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **zì** alone, falling — then **míngzi**, with the second syllable light
- **míngzi** twice, and say what each of its two halves means

Before you move on

Which syllable of *míngzi* carries no tone? (**The second**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

8.6 Practice — saying who you are

Say **wǒ shì** — low and dipping, then falling.

The exchange

Two people meet in the morning. The gap in the third line is yours to fill.

A: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

B: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

A: 我是 …

wǒ shì … — I am … (your name).

B: 我是 …

wǒ shì … — I am … (their name).

A: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

Say it with your own name in it, out loud. That is the first time this book has asked you for something it could not supply.

What you've built — and one thing deliberately withheld

You can now greet by time of day, say who you are, and leave. Every line is built from characters you have written.

One honest gap, and it is worth naming rather than hiding. You have the word for **name** — 名字 — but not yet the way to **ask** for someone's. The natural Mandarin question needs a word this book has not given you, and asking it with only the pieces you have would mean teaching you a sentence a speaker would not say. It is coming, and it is worth waiting for.

What 名字 buys you now is real: you can recognise the word when someone else uses it, and you know that a name is **characters** — which is why a Chinese speaker asked about their name will often tell you which characters it uses.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **wǒ shì**, then your own name, three times
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, taking both parts
- *Write it:* 我是, then 名字

Before you move on

Can you yet ask someone else for their name? (**Not yet** — and the book would rather say so than hand you a sentence nobody says.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 9

What?

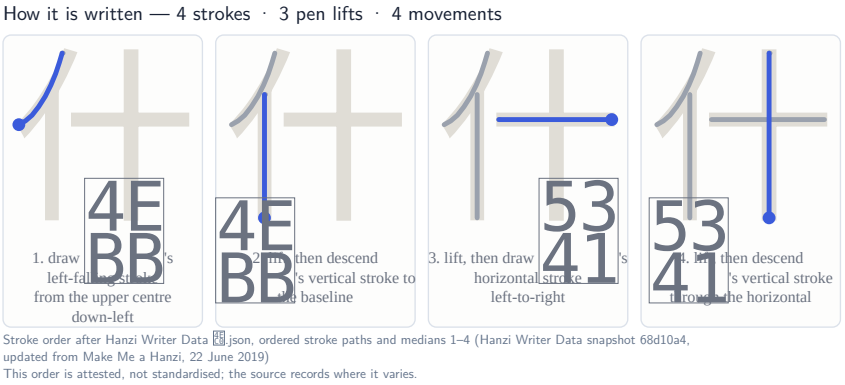
Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write 什 and 么, ask 什么 to mean what, use it on its own to get something repeated, judge that it is blunt with a stranger, and I know its two characters carry the word's sound rather than its meaning.
>
> *The first exchange in the track that goes wrong – one speaker mishears – and the first the reader can repair, which matters more than another memorised line because it is what keeps a conversation alive when the Mandarin runs out.*

9.1 什 — both halves are old news

Write 亻 , the standing person — two strokes, at the left edge of a block.

Script — the shape



How 什 is written, stroke by stroke

什

Four strokes, and after 我 that will feel like a rest.
什 **is** 亻 **beside** 十, and you have met both:

- 亻 you wrote in the very first word of this book, standing at the left of 你
- 十 you drew inside 早, underneath the sun

1. 亻**'s falling stroke**, from the upper centre down to the left
2. 亻**'s vertical**, straight down to the baseline
3. 十**'s horizontal**, left to right
4. 十**'s vertical**, down *through* that horizontal

Three pen lifts.

Finish 亻 **before starting** 十 — left before right, the oldest habit you have. And inside 十, horizontal before vertical, because the two cross.

A note on 十, since this is the second time it has turned up without being taught. It is the character for **ten**, and you still do not need to write it on its own. When it eventually arrives as a character in its own right, you will already have drawn it twice.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 亻 alone, then 什 — the second half is two strokes
- *Write it:* 什 again, saying "person, then ten"
- *Say it:* **shén** — rising

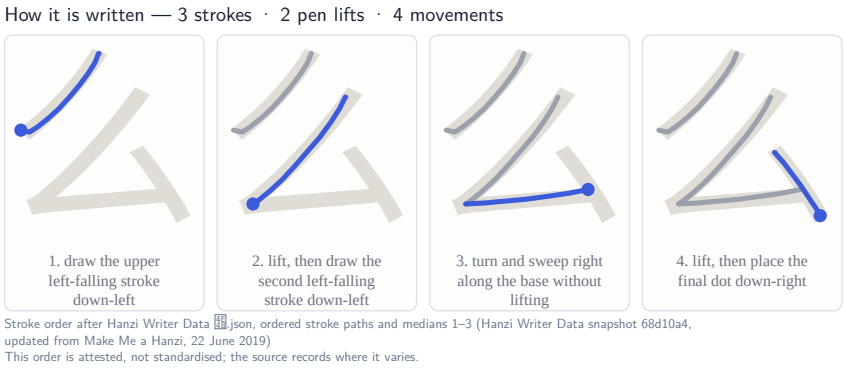
Before you move on

Which stroke of 十 comes first? (**The horizontal** — the two cross.) Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

9.2 么 — three strokes, and one of them turns

Write 什. Person on the left, ten on the right.

Script — the shape



How 么 is written, stroke by stroke

么

Three strokes, and the middle one does the work:

1. a short **falling stroke** at the top, down to the left

2. a second **falling stroke** down-left that **turns without lifting** and **sweeps right** along the base

3. a **dot**, pressed down-right

Two pen lifts.

Stroke 2 is one movement, not two: down-left, then a turn, then out to the right. Lift in the middle of it and you have written something else. You have handled this before — the frame of 再, the leg of 见 — and the instinct is the same: **the pen turns, the stroke does not end.**

The dot goes last, as it did in 我.

The sounds and tones in this word

么 is *me* — and that is the whole pronunciation. **No tone mark, because it has no tone.**
You met neutral syllables inside words, where 上 and 字 gave their tones up. 么 is different: it is neutral in the dictionary, standing alone. Some characters simply never carry a tone, and this is your first.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 么 — and keep stroke 2 unbroken through its turn
- *Say it:* **me** — short, light, flat, no shape to it at all

Before you move on

Why does this character have no tone mark? (**Because it has no tone**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

9.3 什么 — what

Say **me**. Short and flat, no tone at all.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

什么 *shénme* — **what**.
shén rises; *me* is light and toneless behind it. Both characters are ones

you have already written.
This one is different in kind from everything before it. 你好, 是, 不是, 再见, 早上好, 我是 — every one of those **gives** something. 什么 **asks.** It is the first word in this book whose job is to get something back from the other person.
Here the honest note this book owes you: the two halves of 什么 do **not** add up the way 再见's did. 再 and 见 each brought their meaning into the word. 什 and 么 bring only their **sound** — 什 is standing in for how this word is pronounced, not for anything it means.
And keep the levels apart. The pieces you drew *inside* 什 — the person and the ten — belong to that **character**, not to this **word**. "Person plus ten" explains nothing about *what*. Some words are built; others are not.
Where the word comes from is not settled. It appears in writing from about the Tang dynasty, spelled several ways, and its two characters were chosen for their sound.

Why it's said this way

什么? by itself means **"What?"** — the thing you say when you did not catch what someone said. That is real, everyday Mandarin and it is the most useful thing you can do with this word today.
One caution, because register matters and this book would rather tell you than let you find out. A bare 什么? is **blunt** — closer to English "What?" than to "Sorry?". Between friends it is unremarkable. To a stranger, or to anyone you would be careful with, it lands harder than you intend, and Mandarin has gentler ways to ask for a repeat that need words you do not have yet.
So: use it, and know what it weighs.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **shénme** — rising, then light
- *Say it:* **shénme?** as a question, as though you missed something
- *Write it:* 什么

Before you move on

Do the two halves of 什么 add up to its meaning? (**No** — they are there for sound.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

9.4 Practice — when you did not catch it

Say **shénme** — rising, then light.

The exchange

Two people meet. One of them mishears. Fill both gaps with real names.

A: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

B: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

A: 我是 …

wǒ shì … — I am …

B: 什么?

shénme? — what?

A: 我是 …

wǒ shì … — I am … (said again, slower)

B: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

That fourth line is the point of the chapter. Until now every exchange in this book has gone perfectly, which is not what conversations do. **B did not catch it, said so, and got it repeated.** That is a repair, and being able to make one is worth more than another memorised phrase — it is what keeps a conversation alive when your Mandarin runs out.

What you've built — and the question you still cannot ask

You can greet by the hour, say who you are, ask for a repeat when you miss something, and leave.
The gap named last chapter is still open, and it is worth being precise about what changed. You now have 什么, the *what* of "what is your name?" — but not yet the rest of that sentence. Both halves of the question exist in Mandarin; this book has handed you one of them. The other needs a character the font in this book cannot yet print, which is a dull reason, and a true one.
So the honest position: **什么 is a question word you can use today** in the ways above, and a piece of a question you will finish later.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both parts, including the mishearing
- **shénme?** twice — once flat and clipped, once softened and drawn out on the rise. Same word; the second is the one you would risk on a stranger

Before you move on

Is a bare 什么? gentle or blunt? (**Blunt** — fine with friends, heavy with strangers.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 10

One Character, Two Courtesies

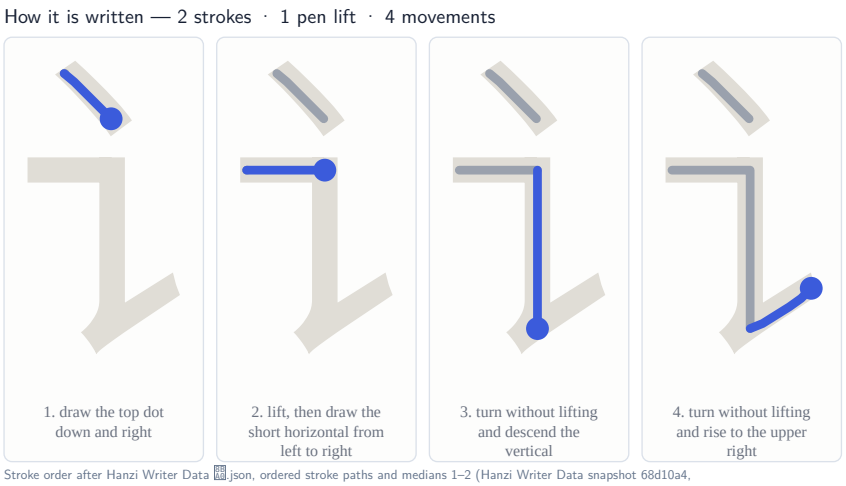
Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write the speech radical 讠 and the twelve-stroke 谢, thank someone with 谢谢, answer thanks with 不谢, and predict from the rule alone that 不 rises before 谢 because 谢 is a falling tone.
>
> *A whole courtesy exchange bought with one new character – doubled for the thanks, negated for the reply – and the first place the reader predicts a tone change from a rule rather than being told how a word sounds.*

10.1 讠 — the speech radical

Write 讠 . Two strokes, squeezed to the left edge of a block.

Script — the shape



How 讠 is written, stroke by stroke

讠

Two strokes, one pen lift, and it is not a character. Like 亻, it is a **component** — a piece that lives at the left edge of other characters.

1. a **dot** at the top, pressed down and to the right
2. a short **horizontal**, which **turns down** and then **finishes rising** to the upper right — all one stroke, no lift

That second stroke does three things without stopping. You have handled worse: the frame of 再, the leg of 见, the turn in 么.

讠 **means speech.** It is the squeezed form of 言, the character for words and speaking, and it does the same job 亻 does: it tells you what the character is *about* before you know how to say it.

讠 joins 亻 as a component that carries **meaning** rather than sound, and the pair is worth holding together:

- 亻 at the left edge → the character is about a **person**
- 讠 at the left edge → the character is about **speech**

You will meet 讠 often. Every time you do, you can guess something true about the word before anyone tells you.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 讠 — dot, then one unbroken turning stroke
- 亻 , then 讠 , side by side — two meaning-carrying components

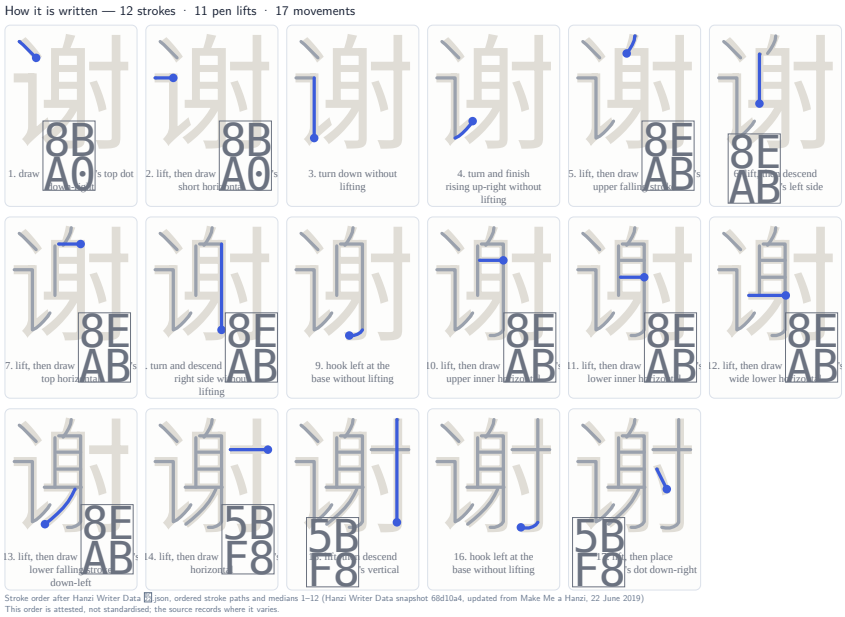
Before you move on

How many pen lifts does 讠 take? (**One**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

10.2 谢 — twelve strokes, and three pieces

Write 讠 . Dot, then one turning stroke.

Script — the shape



How 谢 *is written, stroke by stroke*

谢

Twelve strokes. That is the longest thing in this book, and the number is about to stop mattering.

You were told once that stroke-counting gives out and structure takes over. This is where that pays off. **谢 is three pieces, left to right**, and you have just written the first:

讠 + 身 + 寸

- 讠 — speech, two strokes, done
- 身 — a shape meaning *body*, seven strokes
- 寸 — a shape meaning *inch*, three strokes on the right

身 and 寸 are pieces, not characters you are being asked to own. Read them, place them, move on.

讠 **(strokes 1-2).** As you just practised.

身 **(strokes 3-9).** An upper falling stroke; the left side down; the top and right side in one turning stroke that hooks left at the base; two short inner horizontals; a wide horizontal beneath them; then a falling stroke down-left.

寸 **(strokes 10-12).** A horizontal; a vertical that hooks left at the base; and a dot, last.

Eleven pen lifts. **Left piece finished before the middle, middle before the right** — the oldest habit you have, applied to three pieces instead of two.

Compare it honestly with 我. 我 was seven strokes and had **no** pieces you could hold on to. 谢 is twelve and has three. **The long one is the easier one.** That is the whole argument for learning structure rather than counting.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 讠, then the middle piece, then the right piece — stopping between each
- *Write it:* 谢 straight through, and say "speech, body, inch" as you go
- *Say it:* **xiè** — falling

Before you move on

Which was harder to learn, this one or 我? (我 — and it is five strokes shorter.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

10.3 谢谢 — said twice

Say **xiè** — falling, from high to low.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

谢谢 *xièxie* — **thank you**.
It is 谢 **written twice**. Nothing else. You learned one character and you have the word.
This is new, and it is not a quirk. Mandarin builds a great many words by **saying a piece twice**, and doubling usually softens something — it makes an action smaller, lighter, more everyday. That pattern is worth knowing; you will meet it again.
Two cautions about this particular word, so you do not over-apply it. 谢谢 **is a fixed expression**, not something you assemble fresh each time — it does not mean "to thank briefly". And 谢 **is not said on its own**: it lives inside words, so do not reach for a bare 谢 and expect it to work.
谢 is inherited from Middle Chinese *zjaeH*, glossed "to decline, take leave" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); "to thank" is a later sense, and the doubled form is a Chinese formation.

The sounds and tones in this word

xièxie, not *xièxiè*.
The first 谢 falls. The second **goes neutral** — short, light, no tone mark. You have seen this twice already, on 上 inside 早上 and on 字 inside 名字, and now on a syllable that is the *same character* as the one before it.
That is the useful lesson: **the light syllable is not a property of the character, it is a property of the word.** 谢 falls in this word's first half and goes light in its second — and you will meet 谢 falling again, in its second position, before this chapter is out. *Twice through.*

Say it: *xiè* dropping, then *xie* small and quick behind it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **xiè** alone, falling — then **xièxie**, with the second syllable light
- *Say it:* **xièxie** twice, and say which of the two 谢 carries a tone
- *Write it:* 谢谢 — the same twelve strokes, twice

Before you move on

How many new characters did this word cost you? (**One**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

10.4 不谢 — answering thanks

Say **xièxie** — falling, then light.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Someone thanks you. What do you say back?

不谢

不谢 — and it is made of two things you already have. 不, the negator you have carried since 好 and 不好, in front of 谢, which you learned an hour ago. Nothing new. You could have built this yourself.
It works the way 不是 works: **put 不 in front of the word and you turn it.** Here turning it is a polite refusal of the thanks — *no need to thank me* — which is how a great many languages answer being thanked.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *pjut*, "not", and *zjaeH*, "to decline, to thank" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

The sounds and tones in this word

Before you say it, work it out. **谢 is fourth tone.** What does 不 do in front of a fourth tone?
It rises. *bú xiè*, not *bù xiè* — exactly as 不是 became *bú shì*.

This is the second time that rule has fired, and this time you were told the condition before the word. That is the difference between a rule you have been given and a rule you can use: **you can now predict the pronunciation of a word nobody has said to you yet.** *Twice through.*

Why it's said this way

不谢 is real and correct, and it is not the commonest reply. The one you will hear most often needs two characters this book cannot yet print, so it is waiting. 不谢 will be understood everywhere, and it has the advantage of costing you nothing you did not already have.

Your turn

- *Say it:* **bú xiè** — the first syllable rising, and know why
- *Say it:* **bú shì**, then **bú xiè** — the same rule, twice
- *Write it:* 不谢

Before you move on

How many new characters did this reply cost you? (**None**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

10.5 Practice — thanks, and the answer

Say **bú xiè**. Rising, then falling — and you know why the first one rises.

The exchange

A: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

B: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

A: 谢谢

xièxie — thank you.

B: 不谢

bú xiè — you're welcome.

A: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

Six lines, and **one new character** paid for two of them.

What you've built — one character, a whole exchange

This chapter cost you 谢 and nothing else. Out of it came the thanks (谢谢, the same character twice) and the reply (不谢, a negator you already had). That is what a system does for you that a phrasebook cannot: pieces recombine.
Three things you did here without being led:

- you **doubled** a character to make a word, and knew the second half would go light;
- you **negated** a word to make its answer, the same move that turned 是 into 不是;
- and you **predicted a tone change** from a rule, before hearing the word said.

That last one is the real marker. Early on you were told what 你好 sounds like. Now you are told a rule and you work out what a word sounds like. Those are different kinds of knowing, and only the second one travels to words nobody has taught you.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Say it:* **xièxie**, then **bú xiè** — light on the second, rising on the first
- *Write it:* 谢谢, then 不谢

Before you move on

Which two of these did you work out rather than being told? (**The light second syllable, and the rising 不.**)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 11

After You

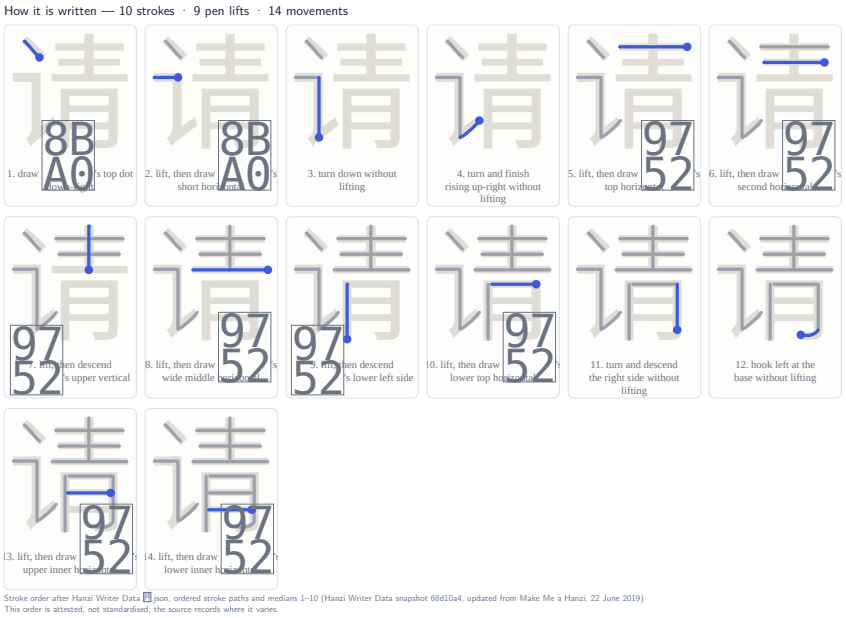
Modes: **voice** (2) **eyes** (2) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write 请, say it on its own to mean after you, explain that it invites rather than softens and so is used far less than English please, and I know a character half can point at the sound instead of the meaning.
>
> *A complete courtesy in four words, and the point at which the reader learns a character can carry two kinds of hint at once – one half for what it means, the other for how it sounds – which is what makes the writing system learnable rather than thousands of unrelated pictures.*

11.1 请 — a half that tells you the sound

Write 讠 . Dot, then one turning stroke. What does it tell you about the word? (**Speech**.)

Script — the shape



How 请 *is written, stroke by stroke*

请

Ten strokes, two pieces, and 讠 is on the left again as you would expect.

讠 + 青

讠 **(strokes 1-2).** Speech. You know it.

青 **(strokes 3-10).** A top horizontal; a second horizontal; a vertical down through them; a wide middle horizontal; then the lower box — its left side, then its top-and-right in one turning stroke that hooks at the base, then two short inner horizontals.

Nine pen lifts. **讠 finished before 青.**

Now the part worth stopping for. In 谢, both halves pointed at **meaning** — speech, body, inch. Here the right half does something else entirely.

青 is said *qīng*. The whole character is said *qǐng*.

Say those two aloud, one after the other. Same consonant, same rest of the syllable; only the pitch differs. **The right half is not telling you what the word means. It is telling you how to say it.** That is a

phonetic component — the job 尔 was doing inside 你, which you could only take on trust there. This time you can hear it. Once you can spot one you have a genuine reading strategy: meet an unknown character, find the half you recognise, and you often have a guess at the sound.

It is a guess and not a guarantee — the sound has drifted in plenty of characters over a few thousand years, and the tone in particular is often different, as it is here. But a guess beats nothing, and you will be right often.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 讠 , then 青 — stopping between the two pieces
- *Say it:* **qīng**, then **qǐng** — the sound half, then the whole character
- *Write it:* 请 straight through

Before you move on

Is the sound half exactly right? (**Not quite** — the tone differs.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart; stroke order per the PRC standard *Xiandai Hanyu Tongyongzi Bishun Guifan* (1997).

11.2 请 — please, and after you

Say **qǐng** — low and dipping, like *hǎo* and *wǒ*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

请 *qǐng* — the word a dictionary will give you as **please**.
That translation is close enough to use and loose enough to mislead, so here is the more accurate version: 请 is closer to **"I ask you to"**, **"I invite you to"**. Where English *please* softens a demand, 请 **hands the action over**.
Which is why it works **on its own**. Hold a door and say 请 — that is *after you*, *go ahead*, *be my guest*. Offer someone a seat and say 请. No other words needed, and none of them would be an apology for asking.
The word is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshjengX*, glossed "to beg, to request, to ask" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the asking sense is the old one.

Why it's said this way

English *please* is a **softener**. You bolt it onto a request to take the edge off, and you can put it almost anywhere: *please sit*, *sit, please*, *could you please sit*.
请 does not work like that. It comes **before the action it invites**, never bolted on after it — there is no Mandarin habit of tacking 请 onto the end of a request the way English tacks on *please*.
The consequence is practical, and it surprises learners: **Mandarin uses 请 far less often than English uses please** — and with people you are close to it can sound distant rather than polite. Leaving it out is not rude the way dropping *please* can be in English. Warmth in Mandarin is carried more by what you say and how you say it than by a single courtesy word.
So: use 请 to hand something over or to invite. Do not reach for it every time you would say *please* in English — you would sound stilted rather than polite.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **qǐng** on its own, as though holding a door open
- **qǐng**, then **xièxie** — the invitation, then the thanks

Before you move on

Does Mandarin use 请 as often as English uses *please*? (**No** — far less.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

11.3 Practice — after you

Say **qǐng** — low and dipping.

The exchange

Two people reach a door at the same time.

A: 请

qǐng — after you.

B: 谢谢

xièxie — thank you.

A: 不谢

bú xiè — you're welcome.

B: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

Four lines, four words, and a complete small courtesy. Nobody in it asks for anything or explains anything, and it still works — which is most of what courtesy is.

What you've built — a component that predicts

Consider what the two halves of this chapter's character bought you. 讠 **on the left** told you the word was about speech before you knew what it meant — and it did the same in 谢. Two characters, one component, one reliable guess.

青 **on the right** told you roughly how to say it. You were told once before that a half could do this — 尔, on the right of 你 — but you had to take it on trust, because 尔 is *ěr* and nothing in it sounds like *nǐ*. Here you can hear it for yourself: *qīng*, *qǐng*.

So the claim made in passing back then is now one you can check: a Chinese character can carry **two kinds of hint at once**, one for what it means and one for how it is said. That is the single most useful thing to know about reading Chinese, and it is why the writing system is learnable at all rather than being thousands of unrelated pictures.

You will not always get both hints, and neither is a promise. But from here on, when you meet a character you do not know, you have something to do other than look it up: **find the half you recognise, and ask which job it is doing.**

Your turn

- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts

- *Say it:* **qǐng**, **xièxie**, **bú xiè** — three courtesies in a row
- *Write it:* 请, then 谢 — and say what their left halves have in common

Before you move on

Which half of 请 would help you guess its pronunciation? (**The right**.)
Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

11.4 Eight exchanges, one meeting

Every chapter so far has ended on a two-voice exchange, and you have practised each one on its own. From memory: the one that opens a meeting, and the one that closes it.

You'll want to know: they were always one conversation

Eight exchanges arrived one per chapter. Put them in the order a meeting uses them and this book's whole first act is there:

the move	what it added
greet	你好, both voices
introduce, ask	a name given, a name asked for
identify, negate	saying it is so, and saying it is not
thank, be polite	谢谢, and the reply that follows it
part	再见

Nothing in that column is new. What is new is that **no chapter ever asked you to run them one after another**, and a meeting is exactly that: eight small moves with no pause between them for looking anything up.

Your turn: the whole meeting, no stops

Say these aloud:

- both voices of the greeting
- give your name, then ask for theirs
- answer a yes-or-no question, once affirming and once denying

- thank them, then give the reply you would receive
- take your leave

Before you move on

Which exchange opens a meeting, and which closes it? (你好 and 再见.) Which pair is a yes against a no? (**Identify** and **negate**.) What did the thanks exchange add beyond the word itself? (**The reply** that comes back.) And what is new here, when every piece is old? (**Running them together**, with no stop.)

11.5 好 — one character, and three things it is not

Say 好 twice, once in each tone you have met, and say what each one means. One character, two words.

You'll want to know: four cautions, and 好 carries three of them

These chapters have warned you four separate times about reading too much into what you see. 好 is where three of the four meet:

- **A character is not a word.** 你好 is two characters and one word. A character writes a syllable and usually a meaningful piece — not a word.
- **A component is not always a meaning.** 好 is 女 beside 子, woman beside child, and the lesson that built it warned you against reading a story into that. The pieces are how the character is *assembled*, not what it argues.
- **A tone is not a decoration.** *hǎo* is good; *hào* is to be fond of. Same character, same strokes, different word.

Script: the component that carries a sound

尔

The fourth caution is the other way round. 尔 is in 你 to say how it **sounds**, not what it means — a component doing phonetic work. Once you expect that, a great many characters stop looking arbitrary.

Against it, 口 *kǒu* (mouth) and 日 *rì* (sun, and also day) are components that do mean what they draw. **Both kinds exist, and the character does not announce which you are looking at.** That is the caution worth carrying forward.

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你好 — then say how many characters and how many words
- *Say it:* 好 in both tones, with both meanings
- *Look:* at 你 and name the component that is there for its sound
- *Say it:* 口 and 日, and what each one draws

Before you move on

How many words is 你好, and how many characters? (**One word, two characters**.) What are the two halves of 好, and what do they tell you about its meaning? (**女 and 子** — and **nothing** you should rely on.) What does 尔 contribute to 你? (**Its sound**, not its meaning.) And which of 口 and 日 means what it draws? (**Both** — which is why the two kinds have to be told apart.)

Chapter 12

People under one roof

Modes: **voice** (10) **eyes** (2) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 14 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write six HSK Level 1 people-and-family words, building 儿子, 女儿 and 家人 only after their spoken meanings and component characters are secure.
>
> *Six family words pass separate listening, speaking, reading and no-model writing checks; pinyin cannot compensate for an unread character, and a strong skill cannot compensate for a weak one.*

12.1 人 — a person

Write it: the two-stroke figure

Then say **wǒ** — I.

What to know first

人 — *rén* — **person**

Hear the rising tone first. Say *rén*. *Read it:* the character you already know

The meaning is singular here: one person. Number comes from context or another word; the character itself does not grow a plural ending.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

人 *rén* is inherited from Middle Chinese *nyin*, "person" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Its *ny* became the Mandarin *r*, as in *rì*.

Your turn

Say **person** in Mandarin. *Read it:* 人
Cover: 人, then wait five seconds
Write it: the character

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 170.

12.2 女 — female, woman

Say **person**. *Write it:* the three-stroke left half of 好

What to know first

女 — *nǚ* — **female; woman**

Say it low: *nǚ*. The rounded vowel is the same written **ü** you met in the character lesson. On its own, 女 labels female gender; it is not a polite way to call out to a woman. Here you are learning the word for reading and building.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

女 *nǚ* is inherited from Middle Chinese *nrjoX*, "woman" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Read it: 女, then cover it
Write it: the character, from the meaning cue **female**

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 152.

12.3 Hear *érzi* — son

Say **person**, then **female**.

What to know first

érzi — **son**

Hear two beats: rising *ér*, then a short, light *zi*. Say the whole word once from the meaning. Keep the characters covered; the new first shape comes next.

Érzi is built from Middle Chinese *nye*, "infant", and *tsiX*, "offspring".

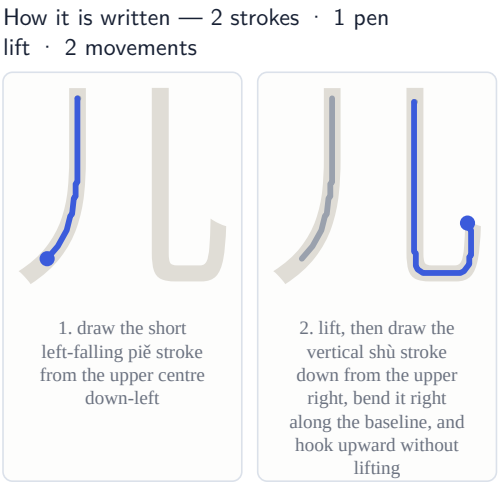
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 48.

12.4 丿乚 — fall, then bend and hook

Say **son**, then write 人.

Script — the shape



How 儿 is written, stroke by stroke

儿

Two strokes. First a short fall down-left. Then start high on the right, descend, bend right along the floor, and hook upward **without lifting**. Unlike 人, the two strokes do not meet at the top.

Your turn

Trace 儿 once. Copy it once. Point to the bend that keeps it apart from 人.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 儿, pinned stroke paths and medians.

12.5 儿子 — son on the page

Say **son**. *Write it:* 儿 and 子 separately

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

儿子 — *érzi* — **son**

The first syllable rises. The second is light. Both characters carry child meanings, but the whole word—not either character alone—is the ordinary kinship word **son**.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *nye*, "infant", and *tsiX*, "offspring" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 儿子, while saying *ér-zi*
Read it: 儿子 once without pinyin

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 48.

12.6 Hear *nǚ'ér* — daughter

Say **female**, then **son**.

What to know first

nǚ'ér — **daughter**

Say two clear syllables: low *nǚ*, rising *ér*. The apostrophe only keeps the vowel boundary visible in pinyin. It is not a pause and not part of the Chinese writing.

Nǚ'ér is built from Middle Chinese *nrjoX*, "woman", and *nye*, "infant".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 153.

12.7 女儿 — daughter on the page

Say **daughter**, then write 女 and 儿 separately.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

女儿 — *nǚ'ér* — **daughter**

Nothing is hidden: 女 gives female and 儿 gives child. Read the two characters without the pinyin, then say the whole word without a pause.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *nrjoX*, "woman", and *nye*, "infant" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Look at 女儿, cover it, wait five seconds, and write it from **daughter**.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 153.

12.8 Hear *jiā* — home, family

Say **daughter**, then **son**.

What to know first

jiā — **home; family**

Hold the pitch high and level: *jiā*. The word can name the household place or the family belonging to it. Keep the character covered; it has ten strokes, and the next lesson gives them to you in two familiar-sized pieces.

Jiā is inherited from Middle Chinese *kae*, "dwelling".

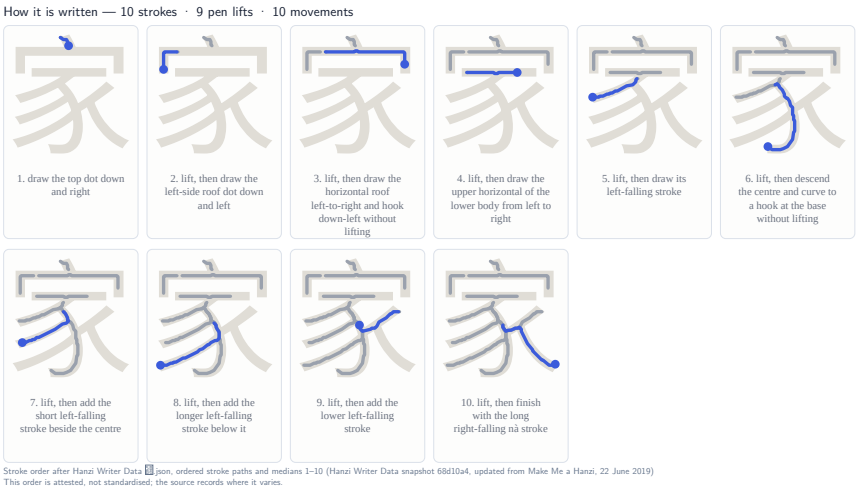
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 86.

12.9 家 — roof first, body second

Say **home**, then write the roof from 字 and the whole character 字.

Script — the shape



How 家 *is written, stroke by stroke*

宀 + 豕 → 家

Finish the three-stroke roof first. Under it, write the lower body from its top horizontal through the centre curve, three left-falling strokes, and the long right-falling finish. Ten strokes; nine lifts.

The old lower component is 豕, livestock. That decomposition is real history and a useful shape boundary. It is not a claim that a present-day home or family is defined by an animal.

Your turn

Trace 家 once. Copy it once, saying **roof**, then **body**.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 家, pinned stroke paths and medians.

12.10 家 — home on the page

Say **home or family**. *Write it:* 宀

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

家 — *jiā* — **home; family**

Read it: 家 once without pinyin
The high line over *ā* records first tone; the character records no tone mark at all.
家 is inherited from Middle Chinese *kae*, "dwelling" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); Mandarin softened its *k* to *j*.

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 家, from the model — name the roof before you write the lower body

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 86.

12.11 Hear *jiārén* — family members

Say **home or family**, then **person**.

What to know first

jiārén — **family members; family**

You already own both sounds: *jiā* + *rén*. The compound names the people of the home. Say it once from the meaning before looking at either character.

Jiārén is built from Middle Chinese *kae*, "dwelling", and *nyin*, "person".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 87.

12.12 家人 — the people of the home

Say **family members**, then write 家 and 人 separately.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

家人 — *jiārén* — **family members; family**

Read from the characters: home + person. The word is plural by meaning here, but Mandarin adds no plural ending to 人.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and the pair is old: it names a hexagram in the Book of Changes.

Your turn

Look at 家人, cover it, wait five seconds, and write it from **family**.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entry 87.

12.13 Retrieve six people and family words

Say **name**. *Write it:* 儿 and 家

Your turn

Hear the six words in a shuffled order and say each meaning. Then, from six English meanings, say each word. *Read it:* the six character cards
Write it: only the two you missed
Repair one item at a time.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary entries 48, 87, and 153.

12.14 Payoff — six family words in four skills

Say **name**. *Write it:* 儿 and 家 without a model

Your turn

1. **Listening:** hear six words in mixed order and choose each meaning.
2. **Speaking:** produce all six from their English meanings, with tones audible.
3. *Read it:* the six character cards without pinyin
4. **Writing:** hear all six. *Write it:* all six without a model

Pass each skill separately. If one misses, repair that skill and retry only that part. This is a family vocabulary map, not yet a full family-description task.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 task outline pp. 2–3 and vocabulary entries 48, 86–87, 152–153, and 170.

Chapter 13

From study to university student

Modes: **voice** (11) **eyes** (3) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first of 17 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write six HSK Level 1 size-and-school words, gaining 大, 学 and 生 one gently staged character at a time before recombining them as 大家, 学生, 大学 and 大学生.
>
> *Three newly secured characters produce six useful words, each checked separately in listening, speaking, unassisted reading and no-model writing.*

13.1 Hear *dà* — big

Say **home** and **family members**.

What to know first

dà — **big; large**

Let the voice fall firmly on the single syllable: *dà*. Keep the character covered for now. The next lesson gives its three strokes one at a time.

Dà is inherited from Middle Chinese *daH*, "big"; the Guangyun also lists a second reading, *dajH*.

Before you move on

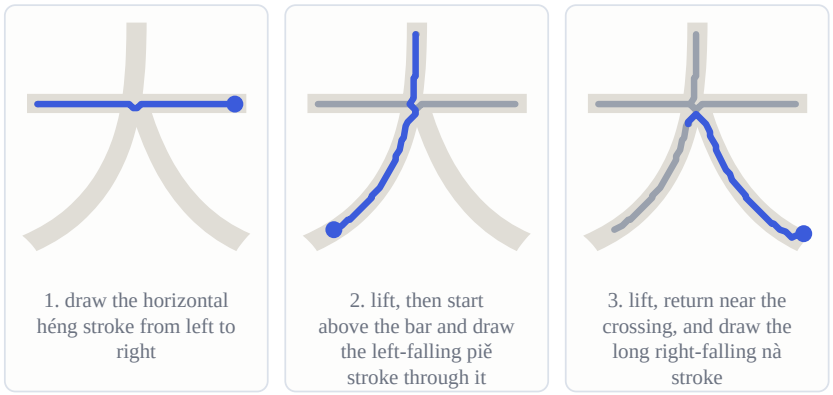
Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.2 大 — one bar, two falls

Say **big** in Mandarin.

Script — the shape

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 59/27.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 大 is written, stroke by stroke

一 + 丿 + 乀 → 大

Write the horizontal first. Start the left-falling stroke above it and cross through it. Lift once more, return to the crossing, and fall long to the right.

Your turn

Trace 大 once. Copy it once while saying **bar, left, right**.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 大, pinned stroke paths and medians.

13.3 大 — big on the page

Say **big**. *Point to:* the first stroke of 大

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大 — *dà* — **big; large**

Read it: the character without pinyin
Then say it once with a clear fourth-tone fall.
大 is inherited from Middle Chinese *daH*, "big"; the Guangyun also lists a second reading, *dajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 大, from the model — keep the crossing near the centre

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.4 Hear *dàjiā* — everyone

Say *dà*, then *jiā*.

What to know first

dàjiā — **everyone; everybody**

Hear two beats: falling *dà*, then level *jiā*. The whole word means everyone. Its written form will contain only characters you already know.

Dàjiā is built from Middle Chinese *daH*, "big", and *kae*, "household".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.5 大家 — everyone on the page

Write 大, then 家 with a small gap.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大家 — *dàjiā* — **everyone**

Close the gap. Read the two characters as one word and keep both tone shapes.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Older texts use the pair for a great household; "everyone" is the later sense.

Your turn

Look at 大家, cover it, then write it once from memory.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.6 Hear *xué* — study, learn

Say **everyone**.

What to know first

xué — **study; learn**

Begin low enough to rise clearly through *xué*. Stay with sound and meaning; the eight-stroke character comes next in small groups.

Xué is inherited from Middle Chinese *haewk*, "to learn".

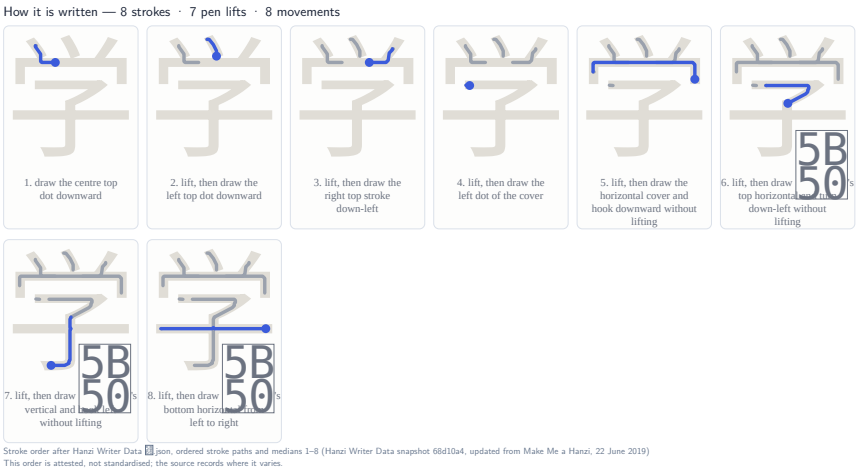
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.7 学 — top, cover, child

Say **study**, then write 子.

Script — the shape



How 学 *is written, stroke by stroke*

⺍ + 冖 + 子 → 学

Place the three short marks across the top. Add the covering dot and hooked line. Finish with the familiar three strokes of 子 below. Eight strokes total; do not let the top marks crowd the child.

Your turn

Trace 学 once. Copy it once while saying **top, cover, child**.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 学, pinned stroke paths and medians.

13.8 学 — study on the page

Say **study**. *Point to:* 子 inside 学

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

学 — *xué* — **study; learn**

Read it: 学 without pinyin, then give the syllable a clear rise
学 is inherited from Middle Chinese *haewk*, "to learn" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); Mandarin lost the final *k*.

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 学 — pause mentally after the top, after the cover, and after 子

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.9 Hear *xuésheng* — student

Say **study**.

What to know first

xuésheng — **student**

Rise on *xué*. Keep *sheng* short and light. Hold the second character back; the next lesson gives its five strokes.

Xuésheng is built from Middle Chinese *haewk*, "to learn", and *srjaeng*, "life, birth".

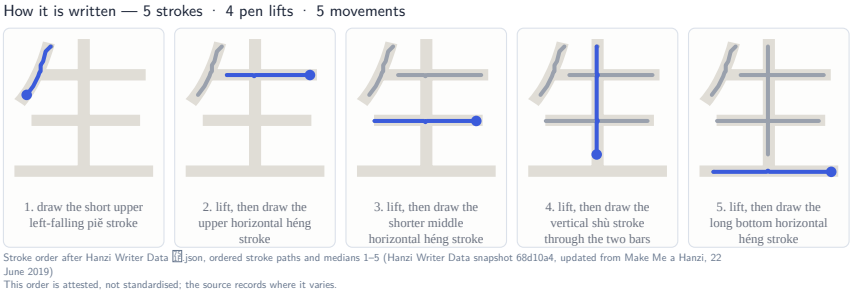
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.10 生 — five measured strokes

Say **student**.

Script — the shape



How 生 is written, stroke by stroke

Begin with the short left-fall. Add the upper horizontal and the shorter middle horizontal. Draw the vertical through their centres, then anchor everything with the long bottom horizontal. Five strokes; four lifts.

Your turn

Trace 生 once. Copy it once while saying **fall, two bars, through, base**.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 生, pinned stroke paths and medians.

13.11 学生 — student on the page

Point to: 学, then 生

Say **study**, then **student**.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

学生 — *xuésheng* — **student**

Read it: the two-character word without pinyin
Keep the second syllable light.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *haewk*, “to learn”, and *srjaeng*, “life, birth” (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription). The pair is an old Chinese compound.

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 学生 — finish all of 学 before beginning 生

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.12 Hear *dàxué* — university

Say **big**, then **study**.

What to know first

dàxué — **university; college**

Let *dà* fall, then let *xué* rise. Together they name a university or college. *Dàxué* is built from Middle Chinese *daH*, "big", and *haewk*, "learning".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.13 大学 — university on the page

Read 大 and 学 separately.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大学 — *dàxué* — **university; college**

Now read the pair as one word: fall, then rise.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The pair is old, the title of a Confucian classic, the *Great Learning*; the sense "university" is modern.

Your turn

Look at 大学, cover it, and write it once from memory.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.14 Hear *dàxuésheng* — university student

Say **university**, then **student**.

What to know first

dàxuésheng — **university student**

Say three beats: falling *dà*, rising *xué*, light *sheng*. Do not repeat *xué*; the two familiar words overlap there.

Dàxuésheng is built from Middle Chinese *daH*, *haewk* and *srjaeng*: big, learning, life.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.15 大学生 — university student on the page

Read 大学, then 学生.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大学生 — *dàxuésheng* — **university student**

Track three characters and three beats. The middle 学 belongs to the whole word only once.
All three pieces are inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH*, *haewk* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and Chinese joined them as university plus student.

Your turn

Look at 大学生, cover it, and write it once. Check one character at a time.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.16 Retrieve six size and school words

Write it: 大, 学, and 生 once each from memory

Your turn

Hear the six words in shuffled order and say each meaning. Then say each word from its English meaning. *Read it:* each character card

Write it: only the missed items

Repair one word at a time.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

13.17 Payoff — six school words in four skills

Write it: 大, 学, and 生 without a model

Your turn

1. **Listening:** hear six words in mixed order and choose every meaning.
2. **Speaking:** produce all six from their English meanings, with tones audible.
3. *Read it:* all six character cards without pinyin
4. **Writing:** hear all six. *Write it:* all six without a model

Pass each skill separately. Repair and retry only the failed skill. This is a school vocabulary checkpoint, not yet a full conversation about education.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 task outline and vocabulary.

Chapter 14

One small step into school

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (2) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write 小, 小学 and 小学生, gaining only the three-stroke 小 before recombining it with the already secure 学 and 生.
>
> *One new glyph expands into three official Level 1 words, each checked independently in listening, speaking, unassisted reading and no-model writing.*

14.1 Hear *xiǎo* — small

Say **big** and **university**.

What to know first

xiǎo — **small; little**

Keep the voice low through the third tone: *xiǎo*. Work only with sound and meaning. Its three-stroke character comes next.

Xiǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjewX*, "small".

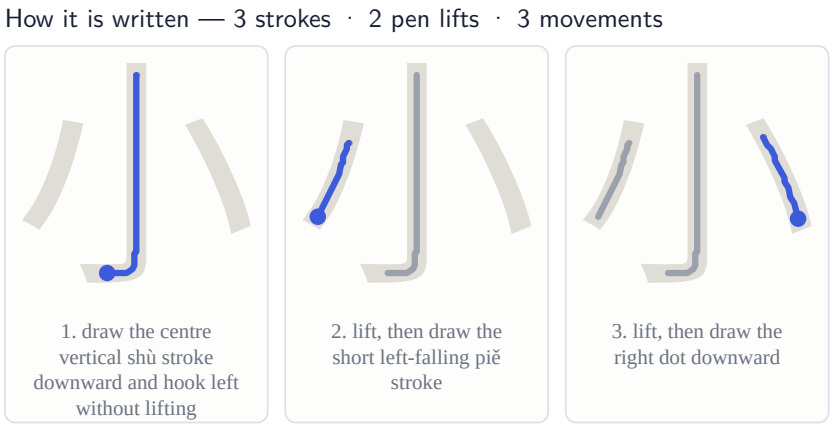
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

14.2 小 — centre, left, right

Say **small** in Mandarin.

Script — the shape



How 小 is written, stroke by stroke

Draw the centre vertical first and finish its hook without lifting. Add the short left-falling mark. Finish with the right dot, leaving air around the centre. Three strokes; two lifts.

Your turn

Trace 小 once. Copy it once while saying **centre, left, right**.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 小, pinned stroke paths and medians.

14.3 小 — small on the page

Say **small**. *Point to:* the first stroke of 小

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小 — *xiǎo* — **small; little**

Read it: the character without pinyin, then say it with a low third tone
小 is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjewX*, "small" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 小 — keep the side marks shorter than the centre stroke

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

14.4 Hear *xiǎoxué* — primary school

Say **small**, then **study**.

What to know first

xiǎoxué — **primary school; elementary school**

Keep *xiǎo* low, then let *xué* rise. No new character is hiding in this word.

Xiǎoxué is built from Middle Chinese *sjewX*, "small", and *haewk*, "learning".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

14.5 小学 — primary school on the page

Read 小, then 学.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小学 — *xiǎoxué* — **primary school**

Read the pair as one word without pinyin: low, then rising.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Older texts use the pair for a child's first schooling; "primary school" is the modern sense.

Your turn

Look at 小学, cover it, and write it once from memory.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

14.6 Hear *xiǎoxuésheng* — primary-school student

Say **primary school**, then **student**.

What to know first

xiǎoxuésheng — **primary-school student**

Say three beats: low *xiǎo*, rising *xué*, light *sheng*. 学 appears only once where the two familiar words overlap.

Xiǎoxuésheng is built from Middle Chinese *sjewX*, *haewk* and *srjaeng*: small, learning, life.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

14.7 小学生 — primary-school student on the page

Read 小学, then point to 生.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小学生 — *xiǎoxuésheng* — **primary-school student**

Track three characters and three beats. Read it once without pinyin. All three pieces are inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX*, *haewk* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and Chinese joined them as primary school plus student.

Your turn

Look at 小学生, cover it, and write it once. Check one character at a time.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

14.8 Retrieve three primary-school words

Write it: 小, 学, and 生 once each from memory

Your turn

Hear **small**, **primary school**, and **primary-school student** in mixed order. Say each. *Read it:* each Mandarin form

Write it: each one

Then contrast 大学 with 小学 and 大学生 with 小学生. Repair only the missed item.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

14.9 Payoff — three primary-school words in four skills

Write it: 小, 学, and 生 without a model

Your turn

1. **Listening:** hear the three forms in mixed order and choose each meaning.
2. **Speaking:** produce all three from their English meanings, with tones audible.
3. *Read it:* all three character cards without pinyin
4. **Writing:** hear all three. *Write it:* all three without a model

Pass each skill separately. Repair and retry only the failed skill.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 task outline and vocabulary.

Chapter 15

A wider school map

Modes: **voice** (13) **eyes** (2) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 17 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write 中学, 中学生, 同学 and 上学 after gaining only 中 and 同 through source-verified, gently staged handwriting practice.
>
> *Four official Level 1 school words are retrieved across four spaced reviews, then checked independently in listening, speaking, unassisted reading and no-model writing.*

15.1 Hear *zhōng* — middle

Say **small** in Mandarin.

What to know first

zhōng — **middle; centre**

Hold one high, level tone: *zhōng*. Stay with sound and meaning. The written shape comes next.

Zhōng is inherited from Middle Chinese *trjuwng*, “middle”.

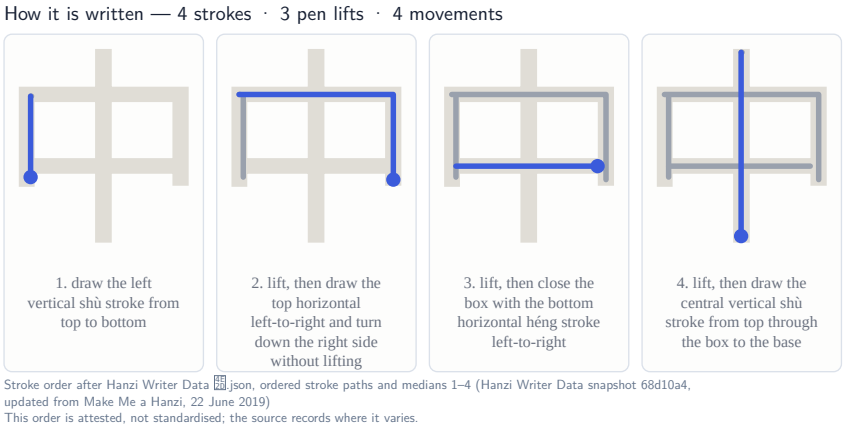
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.2 中 — close, then pass through

Say **middle** in Mandarin.

Script — the shape



How 中 is written, stroke by stroke

Reuse 口's three-stroke box: left side; joined top and right; closing bottom. Only then draw the long centre vertical through the box. Four strokes; three lifts.

Your turn

Trace 中 once. Copy it once while saying **box, close, through**.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 中, pinned stroke paths and medians.

15.3 中 — middle on the page

Say **middle**. *Point to:* 中's last stroke

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中 — *zhōng* — **middle; centre**

Read it: the character without pinyin, then hold its first tone level

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 中 — check that the box closes before the centre line

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.4 Hear *zhōngxué* — middle school

Say **middle**, then **study**.

What to know first

zhōngxué — **middle school**

Hold *zhōng* level, then let *xué* rise. Hear the whole school word before seeing its two characters.

Zhōngxué is built from Middle Chinese *trjuwng*, "middle", and *haewk*, "learning".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.5 中学 — middle school on the page

Read 中, then 学.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中学 — *zhōngxué* — **middle school**

Read the pair without pinyin: level, then rising.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *haewk*

(Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); Chinese built the school name from them.

Your turn

Look at 中学, cover it, and write it once from memory.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.6 Retrieval 1 — middle and middle school

Say **middle** without looking.

Your turn

Hear **middle** and **middle school** in mixed order. Say each. *Read it:* each Mandarin form

Write it: each one, once

Repair only the missed item.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.7 Hear *zhōngxuésheng* — middle-school student

Say **middle school**, then **student**.

What to know first

zhōngxuésheng — **middle-school student**

Say three beats: level *zhōng*, rising *xué*, light *sheng*. The shared *xué* is spoken only once.

Zhōngxuésheng is built from Middle Chinese *trjuwng*, *haewk* and *srjaeng*: middle, learning, life.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.8 中学生 — middle-school student on the page

Read it: 中学, then point to 生

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中学生 — *zhōngxuésheng* — **middle-school student**

Read it: all three characters once without pinyin
All three pieces are inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng*, *haewk* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and Chinese joined them as middle school plus student.

Your turn

Hear *zhōngxuésheng*. *Write it:* 中学生 without looking — check one character at a time

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.9 Hear *tóngxué* — classmate

Say **study** in Mandarin.

What to know first

tóngxué — **classmate; schoolmate**

Let both syllables rise: *tóng-xué*. Keep working only with sound and meaning. The first character comes next.

Tóngxué is built from Middle Chinese *duwng*, "same, together", and *haewk*, "to learn".

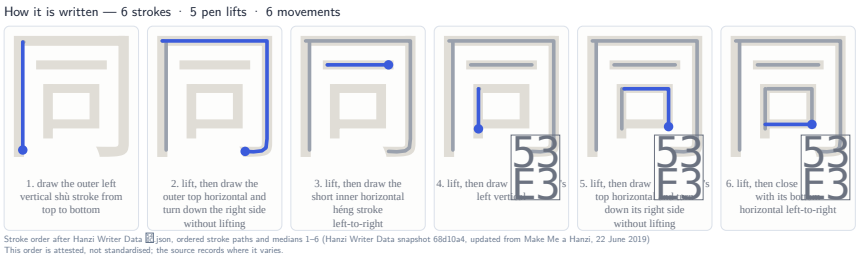
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.10 同 — frame, line, box

Say **classmate**, then air-write 口.

Script — the shape



How 同 *is written, stroke by stroke*

Draw the outer left side. Lift for the joined outer top and right side, ending with its small hook. Add the inner horizontal. Finish the familiar 口 inside: left, joined top-right, closing bottom. Six strokes; five lifts.

Your turn

Trace 同 once. Copy it once while saying **frame, line, box**.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 同, pinned stroke paths and medians.

15.11 同学 — classmate on the page

Read it: 同, then 学

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

同学 — *tóngxué* — **classmate; schoolmate**

Read it: the pair without pinyin
Both syllables rise.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *duwng*, "same, together", and *haewk*, "to learn" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). A classmate is someone who learns with you.

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 同学 — keep the inner 口 inside 同's open-bottom outer frame

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.12 Retrieval 2 — school and people

Write it: 中 and 同 from memory

Your turn

Hear **middle school**, **middle-school student**, and **classmate** in mixed order. Say each. *Read it:* each Mandarin form
Write it: each one
Repair one word at a time.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.13 Hear *shàngxué* — go to school

Say **up / on**, then **study**.

What to know first

shàngxué — **go to school; attend school**

Drop firmly on *shàng*, then rise on *xué*. No new character is hiding in the word.

Shàngxué is built from Middle Chinese *dzyangX*, "to go up", and *haewk*, "learning".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.14 上学 — go to school on the page

Read 上, then 学.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上学 — *shàngxué* — **go to school; attend school**

Read the pair without pinyin: falling, then rising.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *dzyangX*, "to go up", and *haewk*, "learning" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Look at 上学, cover it, and write it once from memory.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.15 Retrieval 3 — place, person, classmate, action

Write it: 中 and 同

Read it: 学

Your turn

Hear four meanings in mixed order: **middle school**, **middle-school student**, **classmate**, **go to school**. Say each. *Read it:* each Mandarin form

Write it: each one
Sort them as place, person, relationship, or action.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.16 Retrieval 4 — the full school ladder

Write it: 小, 中, and 大 from memory

Your turn

Write it: two three-item rows without a model — primary / middle / university; then primary-school / middle-school / university students
Read it: both rows aloud
Write it: 同学 and 上学 onto the rows, from their English meanings

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

15.17 Payoff — four school compounds in four skills

Write it: 中, 同, 上, 学, and 生 without a model

Your turn

1. **Listening:** hear the four words in mixed order and choose each meaning.
2. **Speaking:** produce all four from their English meanings, with tones audible.
3. *Read it:* all four character cards without pinyin
4. **Writing:** hear all four. *Write it:* all four without a model

Pass each skill separately. Repair and retry only the failed skill.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 task outline and vocabulary.

Chapter 16

Character or language?

Modes: **voice** (8) **eyes** (1) **pen** (6) **Hands-free start:** the first of 15 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write 字, 汉字 and 汉语 after gaining 汉 and 语 through source-verified observation, tracing, guided copying and delayed recall.
>
> *Three identity words are retrieved across two expanding reviews, then checked independently in listening, speaking, unassisted reading and no-model writing.*

16.1 Hear *zì* — a written character

Say **middle school** in Mandarin.

What to know first

zì — **a written Chinese character**

You heard a light *zi* at the end of *míngzi*. Standing alone, this word has a sharp falling tone: *zì*. Stay with sound and meaning for this tiny step.

Zì is inherited from Middle Chinese *dziH*; an older sense of the word was "to bear and nurse children".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.2 字 — the familiar shape stands alone

Say **written character** in Mandarin.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

字 — *zì* — **a written Chinese character**

Hide the pinyin. Read 字 from its familiar roof-over-child shape, then say its falling tone. You are attaching a standalone word to writing you already know.
字 is inherited from Middle Chinese *dziH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun quotes the Shuowen dictionary for an older sense, "to bear and nurse children"; "written character" came later.

Your turn

Look at 字 for three seconds. Cover it, wait five seconds, then write it once. Check only two things: roof before child, and six strokes.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.3 Hear *hànzì* — Chinese character

Say *zì* and its meaning.

What to know first

hànzì — **Chinese character; Han character**

The second half is your known *zì*, written character. The first half, *hàn*, labels it as Han Chinese. Hear two clean falling tones: *hàn-zì*. The new first character stays hidden until the next lesson.

Hànzì is built from Middle Chinese *xanH*, first a river's name and then the Han dynasty's, and *dziH*, "written character".

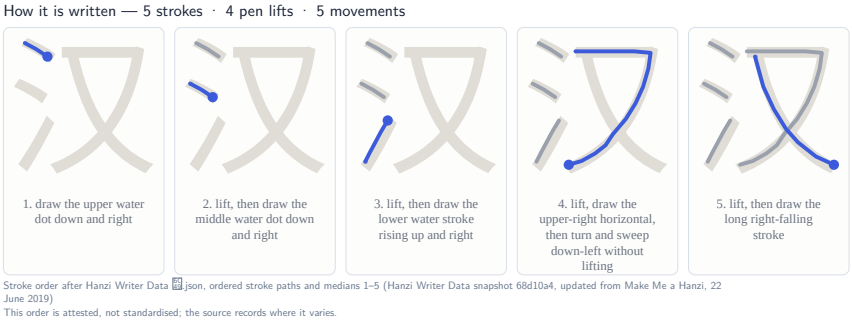
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.4 汉 — watch five strokes

Say **Chinese character**, then point to the new first half of 汉字.

Script — the shape



How 汉 is written, stroke by stroke

In 汉, write 氵 first. On the right, stroke four crosses right and turns down-left without lifting. Stroke five falls down-right. Five strokes; four lifts. Watch the crossing open into two different falling directions.

Your turn

Trace 汉 once, slowly. Say **dot, dot, rise; turn left; fall right**.

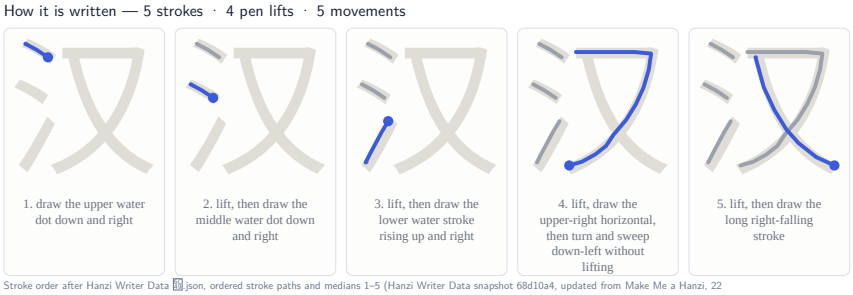
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 汉, pinned stroke paths and medians.

16.5 汉 — copy with a five-part cue

Air-write 氵: dot, dot, rise.

Your turn



How 汉 is written, stroke by stroke

Copy 汉 twice while the model remains visible. First say the five-part cue. On the second copy, pause after 氵 and check that the right side still has only two strokes.

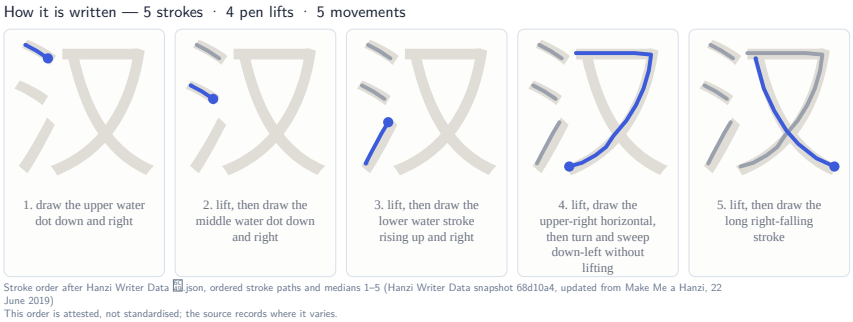
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 汉, pinned stroke paths and medians.

16.6 汉 — hold the route briefly

Look at 汉 for five seconds. Cover it.

Your turn



How 汉 is written, stroke by stroke

Study 汉 for five seconds. Cover it. Say the five-part cue, wait five more seconds, then write once. Reveal the model and repair only the first wrong stroke; do not copy the whole character again unless needed.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 汉, pinned stroke paths and medians.

16.7 汉字 — two known routes, one word

Say **Chinese character** in Mandarin.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

汉字 — *hànzì* — **Chinese character**

Read it: the two characters first without pinyin — Han Chinese + written character
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese. *xanH* was the name of a river (Guangyun); the Han dynasty took its name from that region, and Han came to mean Chinese. *dziH* is "written character".

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 汉字 — leave a small, even gap; do not merge the two squares

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.8 Hear *hànyǔ* — the Chinese language

Say **Chinese character** in Mandarin.

What to know first

hànyǔ — **the Chinese language; Mandarin**

Keep the known falling *hàn*. Then let *yǔ* dip in third tone. The new written half waits; today the contrast is heard: *hànzì* is a character, *hànyǔ* is the language.

Hànyǔ is built from Middle Chinese *xanH*, the Han river and dynasty, and *ngjoX*, "words, speech".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.9 Retrieval 1 — 字 and 汉字

Say **written character**. *Write it:* the same word, without a model

Your turn

Hear **written character** and **Chinese character** in mixed order. Say each answer. *Read it:* each Mandarin form without pinyin

Write it: each one without a model

Repair only the missed item.

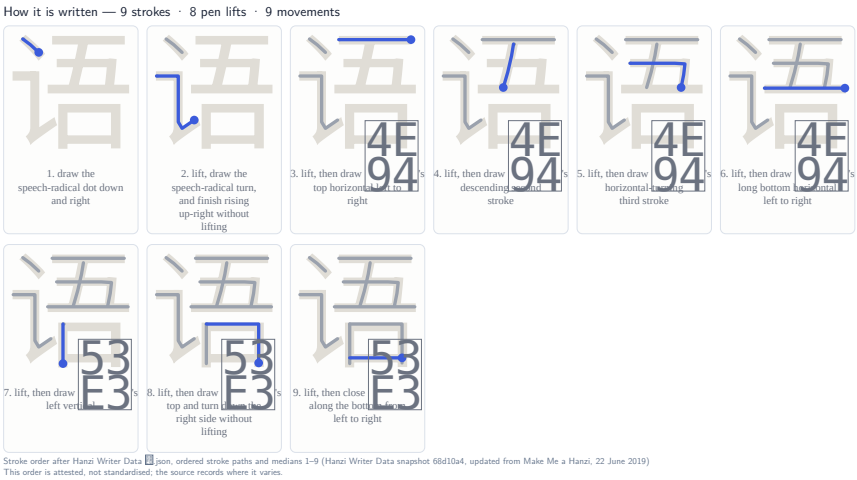
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.10 语 — speech, five, box

Air-write , then say *hànyǔ*.

Script — the shape



How 语 *is written, stroke by stroke*

Write 讠 first. On the right, build 五 from top to bottom, then close 口 at the base. Nine strokes; eight lifts. Keep the speech side narrow so the right side has room.

Your turn

Trace 语 once. Say **speech, five, box** as your hand crosses the three parts.

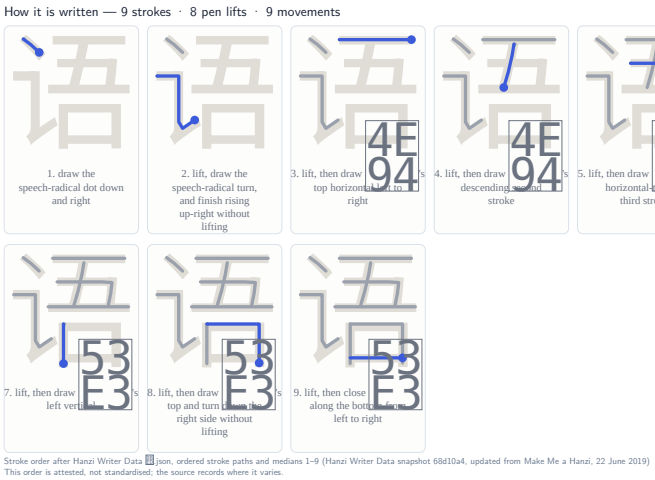
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 语, pinned stroke paths and medians.

16.11 语 — copy, then fade

> Say **the Chinese language**, then point across 语 and say **speech, five, box**.

Your turn



How 语 *is written, stroke by stroke*

Copy 语 once beside the model. Cover it halfway. Copy again from the visible half, keeping 讠 narrow and the final 口 closed.

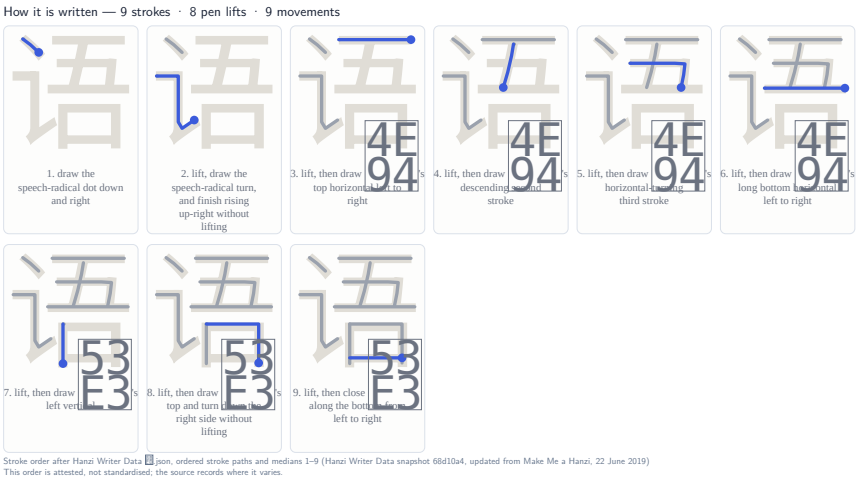
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 语, pinned stroke paths and medians.

16.12 语 — wait, then write

Say **the Chinese language**.

Your turn



How 语 *is written, stroke by stroke*

Look at 语 for five seconds, then cover it.

Tap once for every lift while saying **speech, five, box**. Now write 语 without uncovering the model. Compare only after you finish.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 语, pinned stroke paths and medians.

16.13 汉语 — the language in writing

Say **the Chinese language** in Mandarin.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Read it: 汉语 first, before the explanation

汉语

It joins Han Chinese + language: *hànyǔ*, **the Chinese language**. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *xanH*, the river that gave the Han dynasty its name, and *ngjoX*, “words, speech” (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription).

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 汉语 — keep two separate squares
Read it: the whole word aloud

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.14 Retrieval 2 — character or language?

Say **the Chinese language**. *Write it:* **the Chinese language**, without a model

Your turn

Hear **written character**, **Chinese character**, and **Chinese language** in a mixed order. Say each answer. *Read it:* each answer
Write it: each answer — for the two 汉 compounds, listen for the ending before choosing 字 or 语

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

16.15 Checkpoint — 字, 汉字, 汉语

Write it: 汉 and 语 without a model

Your turn

1. **Listening:** hear the three words in mixed order and choose each meaning.
2. **Speaking:** produce all three from their English meanings, with tones audible.
3. *Read it:* 字, 汉语, 汉字 cold, then give each meaning
4. **Writing:** hear **Chinese character** and **Chinese language**. *Write it:* both without a model

Pass each skill separately. *Check:* the 字 or 语 ending only after both written words are complete

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

Chapter 17

Language or country?

Modes: **voice** (9) **eyes** (1) **pen** (7) **Hands-free start:** the first of 17 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write 中文 and 中国, keep all five identity words distinct, and score listening, speaking, reading and writing separately.
>
> *Two new identity words and the three earlier forms return at expanding intervals before separate listening, speaking, cold reading and no-model writing scores.*

17.1 Hear *zhōngwén* — Chinese

> From the last chapter, say 汉语, 汉字, 字 for **Chinese language, Chinese character, written character**. Then say the sound of 中: *zhōng*.

What to know first

> *zhōngwén* — **Chinese; the Chinese language**

Keep the level first tone in *zhōng*. Let *wén* rise in second tone. The new second character stays hidden for now; this step is only sound and meaning.

Zhōngwén is built from Middle Chinese *trjuwng*, "middle", and *mjun*, "writing".

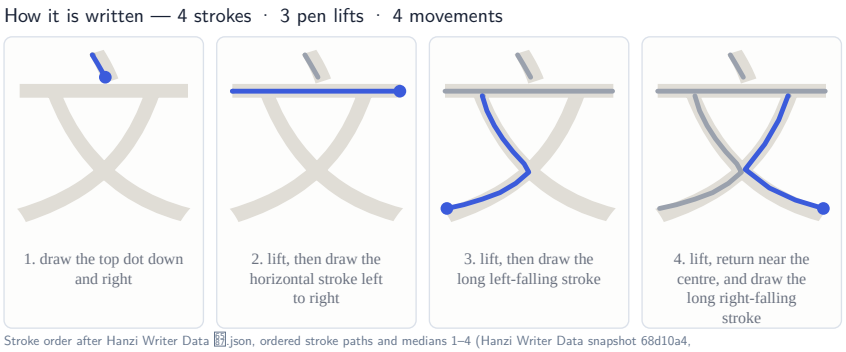
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.2 文 — watch four open strokes

Say **go to school** as *shàngxué* and write 谢 once from memory. Then say **Chinese language** as *zhōngwén*.

Script — the shape



How 文 is written, stroke by stroke

Write 文 in four separate strokes: top dot, horizontal bar, long fall left, long fall right. The last two strokes begin near the centre and open in opposite directions. Four strokes; three lifts.

Your turn

Trace 文 once. Say **dot, bar, left, right** as your hand moves.

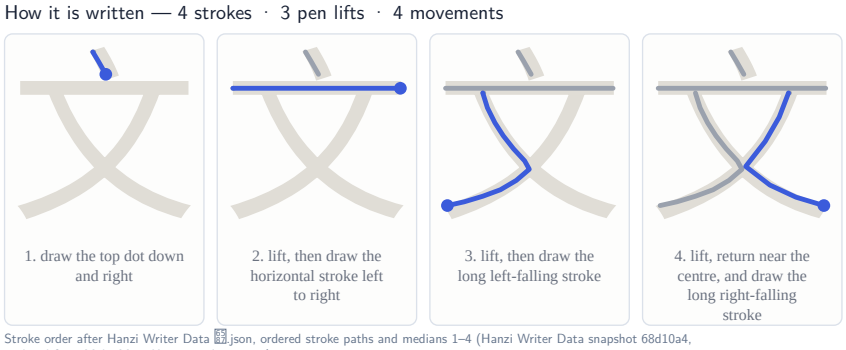
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 文, pinned stroke paths and medians.

17.3 文 — copy with the route visible

Read 上学, say **thank you** in Mandarin, then air-write **dot, bar, left, right**.

Your turn



How 文 is written, stroke by stroke

Copy 文 twice beside the model. On the second copy, pause after the bar and check that the two long falling strokes still open from the centre.

Your turn — Spaced Return

From the cues **thank you** and **go to school**, say 谢谢 and write 上学 once.

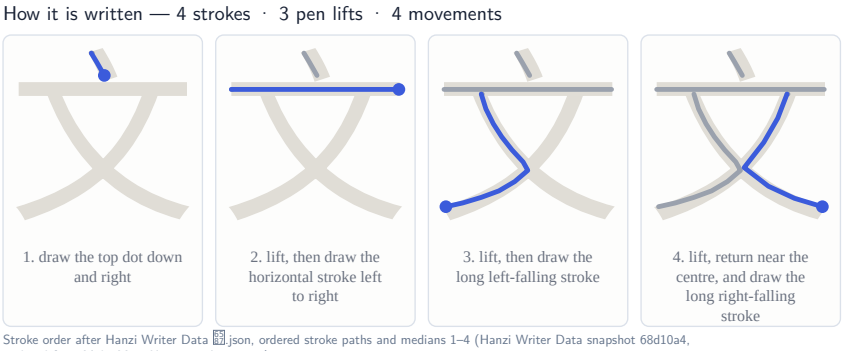
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 文, pinned stroke paths and medians.

17.4 文 — wait, then open the two falls

Answer 谢谢 with 不谢.

Your turn



How 文 is written, stroke by stroke

Look at 文 for five seconds and cover it.

Say **dot, bar, left, right**, then write 文 once without the model. Reveal it only after the fourth stroke. Repair only the first mismatch.

Your turn — Spaced Return

Hear **you are welcome** and write 不谢 without a model.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 文, pinned stroke paths and medians.

17.5 中文 — two known squares

Run the two-line 谢谢 / 不谢 exchange. Then take one Chapter 15 school word by its English meaning and hear its Mandarin word. *Write it:* that word

Read it: that word aloud, then give its meaning

Finally say **Chinese language** as *zhōngwén*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Read it: 中文 first, before the explanation

中文

It joins China or middle + writing or language: *zhōngwén*, **Chinese**. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *trjuwng*, "middle", and *mjun*, "writing" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 中文 — keep the two squares separate and let 文 open at the base

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.6 Longer return — character or language?

Read it: 中文

Write it: 请, pointing to its 青 sound component, then **written character** without a model

Your turn

Hear **Chinese character** and **Chinese language** in mixed order. Say each. *Read it:* each Mandarin form without pinyin

Write it: each one

Listen for the ending before choosing 字 or 语.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.7 Hear *zhōngguó* — China

Say **please**, then say **Chinese language** as *zhōngwén*.

What to know first

zhōngguó — **China**

The first syllable stays *zhōng*. Change the rising ending: *wén* names writing or language; *guó* names a country. The new written ending waits one lesson.

Zhōngguó is built from Middle Chinese *trjuwng*, “middle”, and *kwok*, “state”.

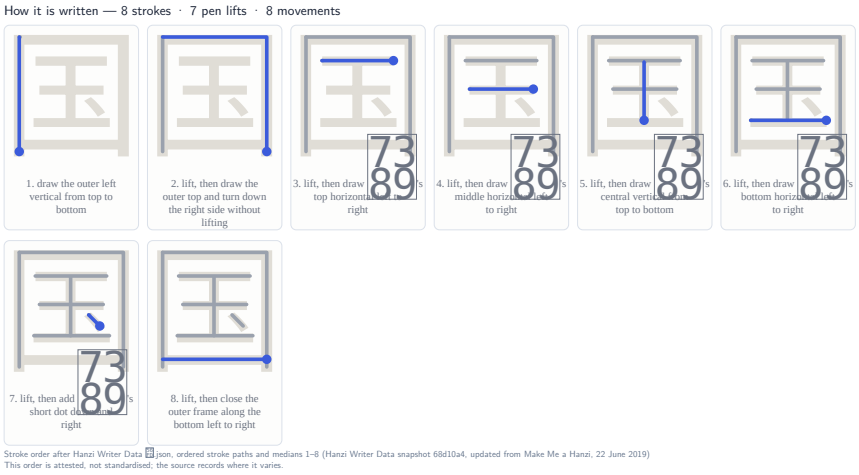
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.8 国 — frame, inside, close

Say **China**. Put 请 before a familiar request, then air-write the opening two strokes of a box without closing it.

Script — the shape



How 国 *is written, stroke by stroke*

Write 国 in eight strokes. Open the outer frame with its left side, then top-and-right. Finish every stroke of 玉 inside. Only then add the bottom bar that closes the frame. Eight strokes; seven lifts.

Your turn

Trace 国 once. Say **frame, three bars, upright, dot, close**. Keep the bottom open until the inner dot is finished.

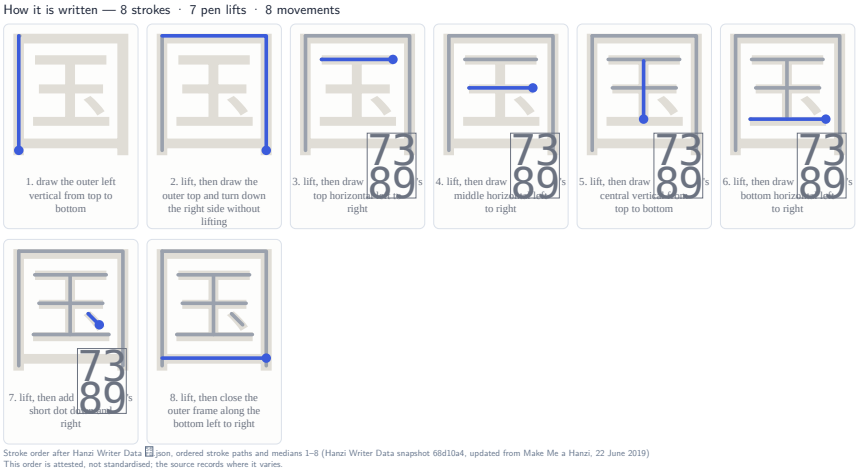
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 国, pinned stroke paths and medians.

17.9 国 — copy with the frame open

Say the meaning of 人 and write 汉 once from memory. Then say **frame, inside, close**.

Your turn



How 国 is written, stroke by stroke

Copy 国 twice beside the model. On the second copy, pause after the inner dot. Check that the outer bottom is still open; then close it with stroke eight.

Your turn — Spaced Return

From the cues **person** and **Han**, say 人 and write 汉 once without a model.

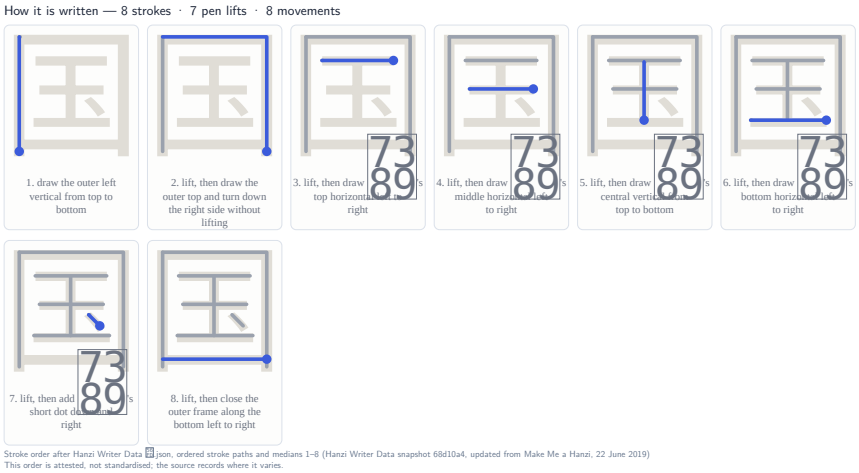
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 国, pinned stroke paths and medians.

17.10 国 — wait before closing

Say what 女 means.

Your turn



How 国 is written, stroke by stroke

Look at 国 for five seconds and cover it.

Say **frame, inside, close**, then write 国 once without the model. Do not uncover it until the bottom bar is complete.

Your turn — Spaced Return

Hear **woman** and write 女 without a model.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 国, pinned stroke paths and medians.

17.11 中国 — China in two squares

Say **son** as *érzi*, then say **China** as *zhōngguó*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Read it: 中国 first, before the explanation

中国

The shared 中 is followed by 国, country: *zhōngguó*, **China**. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The pair is very old and first meant the central states, the realm at the middle; it became the country's name much later.

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 中国 — in 国, finish the inner 玉 before closing the bottom

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.12 Retrieval 1 — language or country?

Write it: 儿 once from memory

Then say **Chinese language**. *Write it:* the same word, without a model

Your turn

Hear **Chinese language** and **China** in mixed order. Say each answer. *Read it:* each Mandarin form without pinyin

Write it: each one — keep 中 and retrieve the correct ending

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.13 Longer return — the older three

Say **the Chinese language** with the 汉 beginning.

Your turn

Write it: without looking back, **written character**, **Chinese character**, and **Chinese language**

Read it: each answer aloud only after all three are complete

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.14 Listening score — five meanings

Say **daughter**, then say **Chinese language** with 中 and **China**.

Your turn

Keep the page covered. Hear the five Mandarin words in mixed order and give the English meaning of each. Then reverse the direction and say all five Mandarin forms. Score listening and speaking separately out of five.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.15 Reading score — no pinyin

Read it: 中国 and 中文 without saying their pinyin first

Your turn

Read it: five unpointed cards in a shuffled order — 汉语, 字, 中国, 汉字, 中文 — each cold, then give its meaning

Score one point per form; pronunciation help comes only after the reading score is recorded.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.16 Writing score — from sound, no model

Say what 家 means. Write 家, 汉, 语, 文, 国 without a model. Check only after all five are complete.

Your turn

First say what 家 means, then recover 汉, 语, 文, 国 once from their spoken syllables. Next hear **Chinese character**, **Chinese language with** 汉, **Chinese language with** 中, and **China** in mixed order. Write all four without a model. Score the four whole words first; then repair only a missed character.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

17.17 Payoff — five identity words

Write 家, 文, and 国 without a model, then name each aloud.

Your turn

1. **Listening, /5:** hear all five words in mixed order and choose each meaning.
2. **Speaking, /5:** produce all five from meaning cards, with tones audible.
3. **Reading, /5:** read 中国, 汉语, 字, 中文, 汉字 cold, without pinyin.
4. **Writing, /5:** hear all five meanings and write each form without a model.

Pass each skill separately. A miss in one column does not cancel the other three. For repair, revisit only the missed form and retry that skill.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

Chapter 18

Looking and reading

Modes: **voice** (12) **eyes** (5) **pen** (6) **Hands-free start:** the first of 23 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write 看, 看见, 好看, 书 and 看书, and score listening, speaking, reading and writing separately.
>
> *Two carefully staged characters support five nearby meanings, expanding retrieval and separate listening, speaking, cold-reading and no-model writing scores.*

18.1 Hear *kàn* — look or watch

> Say **Chinese language** and **China** in Mandarin. Keep those answers separate. *Cover:* the cards, and put them away.

What to know first

> *kàn* — **“look at”; “watch”**

Start high and let the tone fall cleanly. The written form stays hidden in this first step so sound and meaning can settle before handwriting begins.

Kàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *khanH*, “to look”, also read *khan*.

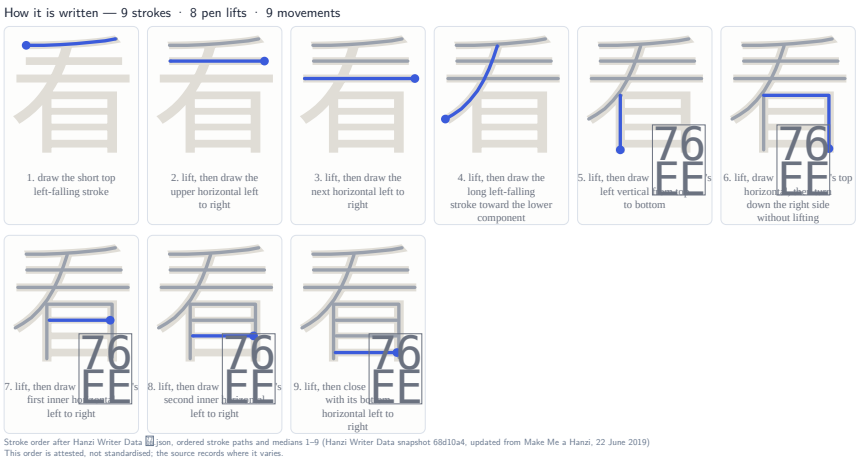
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.2 看 — a hand above an eye

Say **look or watch** as *kàn*. Then write the familiar 中 once and put it away before meeting the new shape.

Script — the shape



How 看 is written, stroke by stroke

Write 看 in nine strokes. Make the short top stroke first, then the two crossing strokes and the long left fall above. Finish with 目 below: left, top-and-right, two inner bars, bottom. Nine strokes; eight lifts.

Your turn

Trace 看 once. Say **hand above, eye below** while keeping the lower box wide enough for its two inner bars.

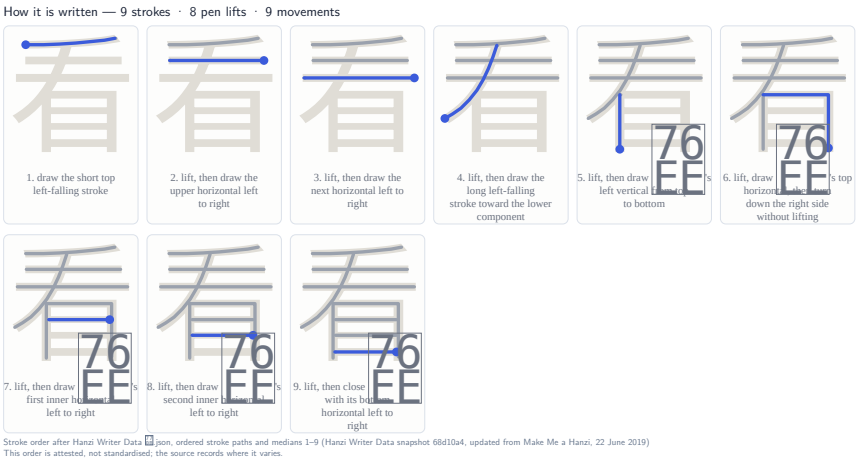
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 看, pinned stroke paths and medians.

18.3 看 — copy hand above, eye below

Read 中文 and give its meaning. Then air-write **hand above, eye below**.

Your turn



How 看 is written, stroke by stroke

Copy 看 twice beside the model. On the second copy, pause before 目 and check that the long falling stroke points toward the eye rather than through it.

Your turn — Spaced Return

Hear **Chinese language with 中** and write **中文** once without pinyin.

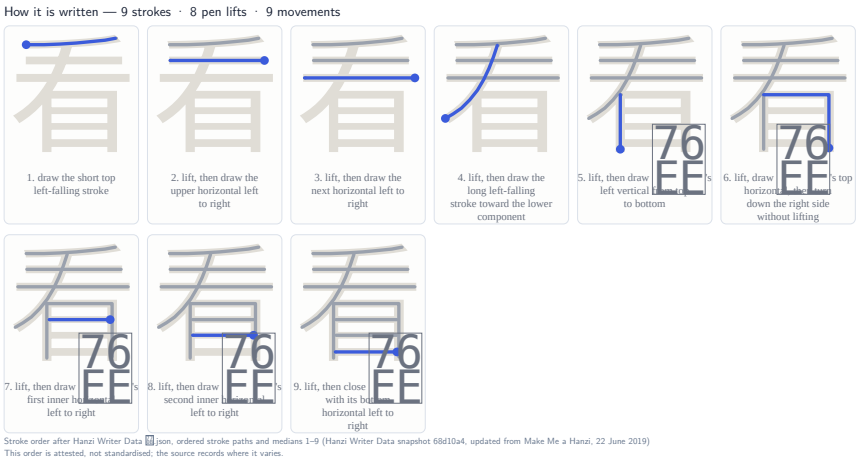
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 看, pinned stroke paths and medians.

18.4 看 — wait, then recover the eye

Write **中国** from the meaning **China**.

Your turn



How 看 *is written, stroke by stroke*

Look at 看 for five seconds and cover it.

Say **hand above, eye below**, then write 看 once without the model. Reveal it only after all nine strokes. Repair only the first mismatch.

Your turn — Spaced Return

Hear **China** once more and write 中国 without a model.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 看, pinned stroke paths and medians.

18.5 看 — the familiar sound meets the shape

Say **look at or watch** in Mandarin.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

看 — *kàn* — **look at; watch**

Hide the pinyin. Read 看 from the hand-over-eye shape, say the falling tone, then give the meaning. One form now connects listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

看 is inherited from Middle Chinese, where the Guangyun lists it as *khan* and *khanH*, "to look" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); Mandarin *kàn* continues the second. The hand over the eye is the history of the character.

Your turn

Hear *kàn*. Wait three seconds, then write 看 once without a model.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.6 Hear *kànjiàn* — see

Say **look or watch** as *kàn*, then say **goodbye** as *zàijiàn*.

What to know first

kànjiàn — **see; catch sight of**

Both syllables fall. The familiar *jiàn* now follows *kàn*: you look and successfully perceive. Keep the characters hidden for this sound-first step.

Kànjiàn is built from Middle Chinese *khanH*, "to look", and *kenH*, "to see".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.7 看见 — looking reaches seeing

Say **see** as *kànjiàn*. *Write it:* 看

Point to: 见 in 再见

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

看见 — *kànjiàn* — **see; catch sight of**

Read it: the two known shapes from left to right

看 supplies looking; 见 marks the perceived result.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *khanH*, "look", and *kenH*, "see" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 看见 — leave a clear boundary between the nine-stroke 看 and the four-stroke 见

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.8 Hear *hǎokàn* — good-looking

Say **good**, **look**, and **see** as three separate Mandarin answers.

What to know first

hǎokàn — **good-looking; nice to look at**

Let *hǎo* dip, then let *kàn* fall. This is a description, not an instruction to look. The characters wait until the next tiny step.

Hǎokàn is built from Middle Chinese *xawX*, "good", and *khanH*, "to look".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.9 好看 — good to look at

Say **good-looking** as *hǎokàn*. Write 好 and 看 separately.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好看 — *hǎokàn* — **good-looking; nice to look at**

No new character is hiding here. Read 好, then 看, and let the literal pieces carry you to the whole meaning.

Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *xawX*, "good", and *khanH*, "look" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Copy 好看 once. Keep both characters full-sized instead of squeezing 看.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.10 Retrieval 1 — look, see, or good-looking?

Say **look**, **see**, and **good-looking** in that order.

Your turn

Hear the three meanings in mixed order. Listen for what comes beside *kàn* before deciding the whole meaning, then say each Mandarin answer. *Read it:* each Mandarin form without pinyin

Write it: each one

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.11 Hear *shū* — book

Say **look**, **see**, and **good-looking** in Mandarin.

What to know first

shū — **book**

Hold one level first tone. Do not add *kàn* yet; this step is only the object, **book**. Its four-stroke written form waits until the next lesson.

Shū is inherited from Middle Chinese *syo*, "writing".

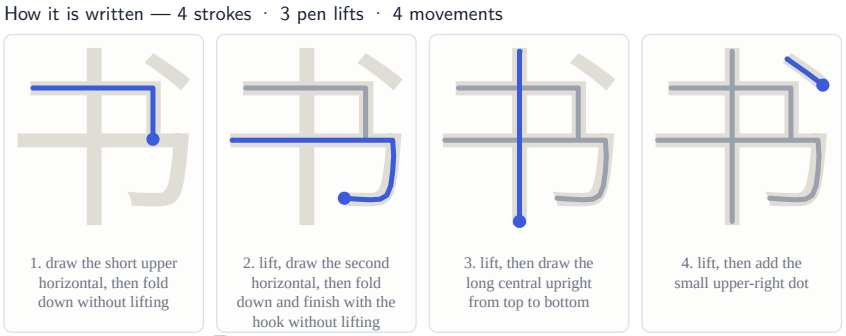
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.12 书 — two folds, upright, dot

Say **book** as *shū*, then write 看 once from memory.

Script — the shape



How 书 is written, stroke by stroke

Write 书 in four strokes: a short horizontal that folds down, a second horizontal that folds and hooks, the long central upright, then the small dot at the upper right. Four strokes; three lifts.

Your turn

Trace 书 once. Say **fold, hooked fold, upright, dot**. Let the upright pass through the middle instead of leaning toward the dot.

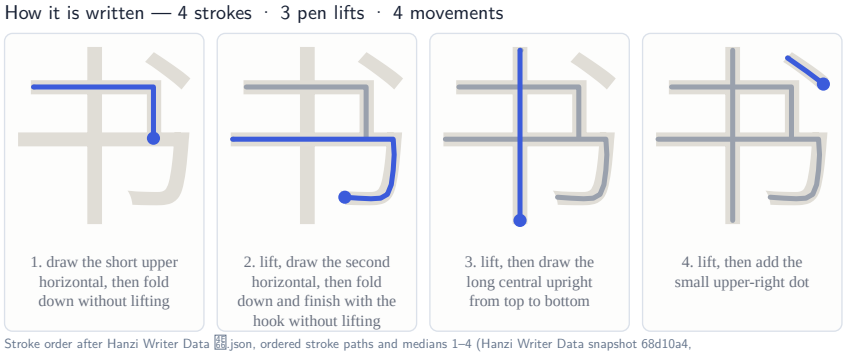
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 书, pinned stroke paths and medians.

18.13 书 — copy the compact route

Read 看见 and give its meaning. Then air-write **fold, hooked fold, upright, dot**.

Your turn



How 书 is written, stroke by stroke

Copy 书 twice beside the model. On the second copy, pause before the upright and check that both folds leave a clear central route.

Your turn — Spaced Return

Hear **see** and write 看见 once without a model.

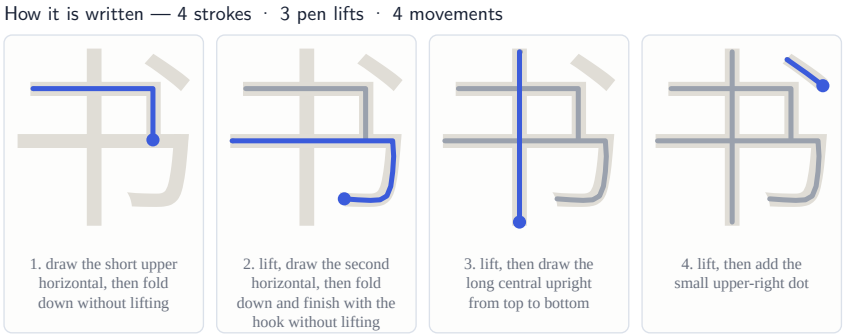
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 书, pinned stroke paths and medians.

18.14 书 — wait, then place the dot

Write 好看 from the meaning **good-looking**.

Your turn



How 书 is written, stroke by stroke

Look at 书 for five seconds and cover it.

Say **fold, hooked fold, upright, dot**, then write 书 once without the model. Check only after the dot is in place.

Your turn — Spaced Return

Hear **good-looking** and write 好看 without a model.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 书, pinned stroke paths and medians.

18.15 书 — the sound meets the shape

Say **book** in Mandarin.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

书 — *shū* — **book**

Cover: the pinyin
Read it: 书, hold the level first tone, then give its meaning
书 is inherited from Middle Chinese *syo*, "writing" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); "book" grew from it.

Your turn

Hear *shū*. Wait three seconds. *Write it:* 书 once, without a model

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.16 Hear *kànshū* — read a book

Say **look or watch**, then say **book**.

What to know first

kànshū — **read a book; read books**

Let *kàn* fall and keep *shū* level. Mandarin says **look-at + book** for the activity **read**. Keep the characters hidden for one more tiny step.

Kànshū is built from Middle Chinese *khanH*, "to look", and *syo*, "writing".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.17 看书 — look at a book, read

Say **read a book** as *kànshū*. Write 看 and 书 separately.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

看书 — *kànshū* — **read a book; read books**

Read the action first and its object second. No new character is hiding here: 看 + 书 gives the whole reading activity.
Both are inherited from Middle Chinese: *khanH*, "look", and *syo*, "writing, book" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Copy 看书 once. Keep the long upright in 书 centred after the denser 看.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.18 Retrieval 2 — the earlier three return

Say **read a book** in Mandarin, then set that word aside.

Your turn

Write it: without looking back, **look**, **see**, and **good-looking** from mixed meaning cards

Read it: each answer aloud only after all three are complete

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.19 Retrieval 1 — book or read a book?

Say **book**, then say **read a book**.

Your turn

Hear the two meanings in mixed order. Listen for *kàn* before deciding noun or activity, then say each answer. *Read it:* each Mandarin form without pinyin

Write it: each one

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.20 Listening score — five nearby meanings

Say **look** and **book** in Mandarin.

Your turn

Keep the page covered. Hear all five Mandarin forms in mixed order and give each meaning. Then reverse the direction and say all five Mandarin forms. Score listening and speaking separately out of five.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.21 Reading score — no pinyin

Read it: 看 and 书 without saying their pinyin first

Your turn

Read it: five unpointed cards in a shuffled order — 好看, 书, 看见, 看书, 看 — each cold, then give its meaning

Score one point per form before any pinyin help.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.22 Writing score — sound to Hanzi, no model

Write it: 看 and 书 from their spoken syllables — check only after both are complete

Your turn

Hear the five meanings in mixed order. *Write it:* all five forms without a model

Score each whole form first. Then repair only the first missed character or ordering choice.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

18.23 Payoff — looking and reading

Write 看 and 书 without a model, then name each aloud.

Your turn

1. **Listening, /5:** hear all five forms in mixed order and choose each meaning.
2. **Speaking, /5:** produce all five from meaning cards, with tones audible.
3. **Reading, /5:** read 看书, 好看, 书, 看见, 看 cold, without pinyin.
4. **Writing, /5:** hear all five meanings and write each form without a model.

Pass each skill separately. Repair only a missed form in the missed skill, then retry that column without cancelling the other three scores.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

Chapter 19

Asking

Modes: **voice** (12) **eyes** (2) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first of 17 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand, say, read and write 吗, 你好吗, 是吗 and 好不好, turn any statement I already own into a yes-or-no question by either of Mandarin's two patterns, and score listening, speaking, reading and writing separately.
>
> *Before this chapter the track could greet, name, count to five and say what it read, and could not ask a yes-or-no question about any of it. One character closes that and does more than its own weight:* 吗 *goes on the end of a finished sentence and changes nothing else, so every statement already taught becomes a question. The second pattern costs no character at all – it is* 不*, held since the negation lesson, placed between two copies of a word.*

19.1 Hear *ma* — the syllable that asks

> Say **look**, **book**, and **read a book** in Mandarin. Name your four scores from the looking-and-reading payoff, and which of the four was lowest.

What to know first

> *ma* — **the question particle**

Say it light, short and flat. It carries **no tone**, which makes it the first syllable in this book with none — every earlier one has been first, second, third or fourth. Give it none at all, and no stress either.

It also carries **no meaning** on its own. There is nothing to translate. What it does is turn the sentence in front of it into a question, and it does that without moving a single other word.

Hear *kàn shū* and then *kàn shū ma*. The words are identical and in the same order; only the light syllable at the end is new, and only the second one is asking.

Ma is usually explained as coming from Middle Chinese *mju*, "not have", said at the end of a question; the account is not settled.

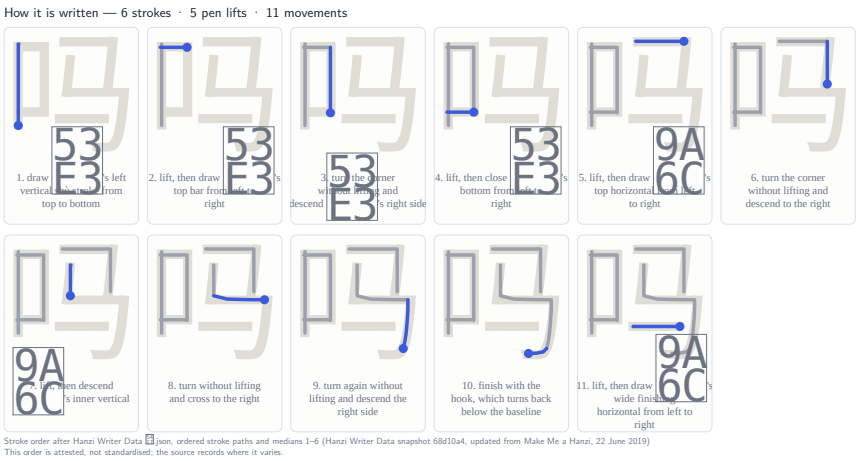
Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.2 吗 — the mouth, then the horse

Say the neutral question syllable. Then write 口 in three strokes, and write 书 once from memory.

Script — the shape



How 吗 is written, stroke by stroke

Write 吗 in six strokes, left part first and complete:

- 口 on the left, small and lifted toward the top: the left vertical, then the horizontal that turns down the right side without lifting, then the closing bottom bar. Three strokes, as you already write it.

- 马 on the right, which supplies only the sound: a horizontal that turns down, then a long stroke that turns twice and hooks, then one wide horizontal across the whole right side. Three strokes.

Six strokes, five lifts. The 口 shrinks to about a third of the square and sits high; the wide final horizontal is the widest thing in the character and runs almost to the right edge.

The left half is doing real work even though it is not saying anything: 口 means *mouth*, and it marks 吗 as one of a family of characters that exist only to be spoken.

Your turn

Trace 吗 once. Say **mouth, mouth, mouth — turn, turn-and-hook, long bar**. Finish the whole 口 before starting the right half, and keep it small.

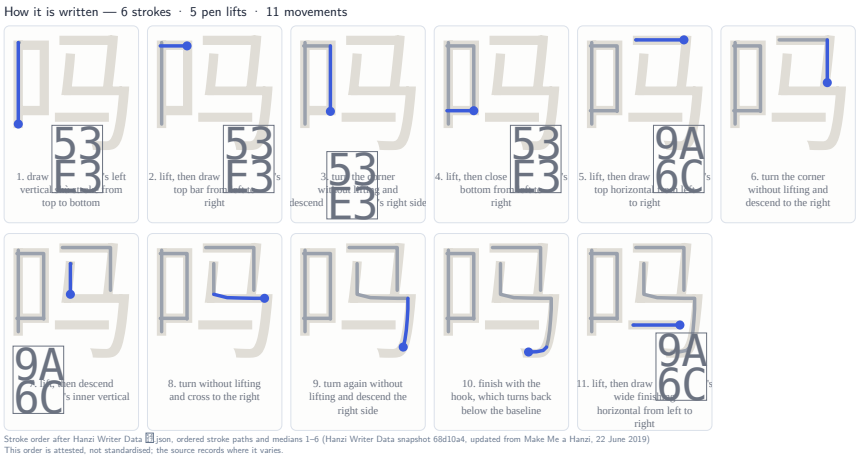
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 吗, pinned stroke paths and medians.

19.3 吗 — copy it, and keep the mouth small

Read 看书 and give its meaning. Then air-write **mouth, mouth, mouth — turn, turn-and-hook, long bar**. Say **see** and **primary school**, and write 看见.

Your turn



How 吗 is written, stroke by stroke

Copy 吗 twice beside the model. On the second copy, stop after the third stroke and check two things before going on: the 口 fills about a third of the width, and its bottom sits above the middle of the square.

Your turn — Spaced Return

Hear **read a book** and write 看书 once without a model.

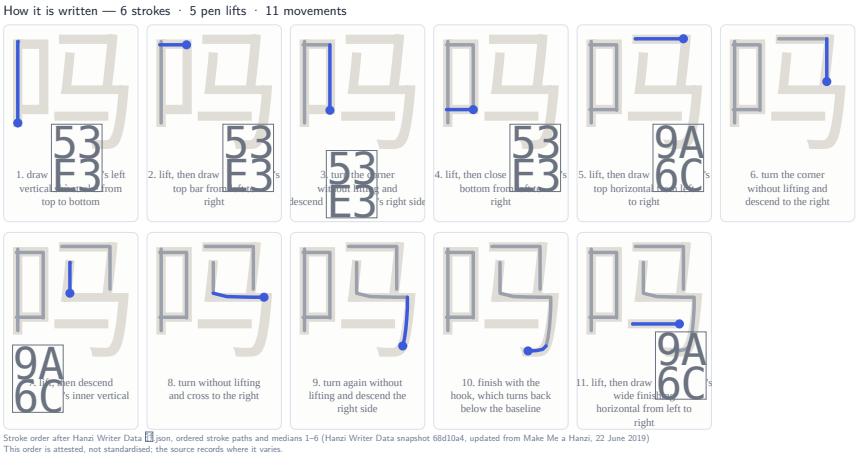
Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 吗, pinned stroke paths and medians.

19.4 吗 — wait, then write the bar

Say the neutral question syllable, then write 书 once from memory.

Your turn



How 吗 is written, stroke by stroke

Look at 吗 for five seconds. Cover it, wait five more, then write it once. Uncover and check the order: all three strokes of 口 before anything on the right.

Most characters give you a meaning to hang the shape on. This one does not — it means nothing by itself — so the route is all you have, and that is why it gets its own delay.

Before you move on

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 吗, pinned stroke paths and medians.

19.5 吗 — the sound meets the shape

Say the neutral question syllable. Then say **look** and **read a book**. Say **good-looking** and **primary-school pupil**. *Write it:* 小

Recall your four looking-and-reading scores.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

吗 — *ma* — **the question particle**

Cover: the pinyin

Read it: 吗, give it no tone at all, then say what it does rather than what it means
吗 is usually explained as coming from Middle Chinese *mju*, "not have" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), tagged onto the end of a question, and later written with this character for its sound. The account is common but not settled.

Grammar lens — one character, every statement

Put 吗 at the **end** of a statement and the statement becomes a yes-or-no question. Nothing else changes:

- 你看书 — *nǐ kàn shū* — you read books.
- 你看书吗 — *nǐ kàn shū ma* — **do** you read books?

Same words. Same order. One character added at the end.
That is worth stopping on, because it is not how English works: English moves words about and borrows a helper verb — *you read* becomes *do you read* — and Mandarin does neither. Every statement you can already make is now also a question you can ask, and there are no new words to learn to ask any of them.
Chinese closes both of those lines with a mark of its own — a small hollow circle for the statement and a question mark for the question. Neither mark is taught yet, so neither is printed here.

Your turn

Hear *ma*. Wait three seconds. *Write it:* 吗 once, without a model
Then take any sentence you own and put 吗 on the end of it.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.6 Hear *nǐ hǎo ma* — how are you

Say **hello**. Then say the neutral syllable that turns a statement into a question.

What to know first

nǐ hǎo ma — **how are you?**

The very first thing this book taught you, with the very newest thing on the end of it. No new word arrives here at all.

Two third tones in a row still slide the first one up, exactly as they do in *nǐ hǎo* on its own — the light *ma* on the end changes nothing about that.

Nǐ hǎo ma is the greeting with the question particle added; *hǎo* is inherited from Middle Chinese *xawX*, "good".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.7 你好吗 — the greeting, asked

Say **how are you**. *Write it:* 你 and 好, then 好看 too

Say what the 好 is doing in 好看.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

你好吗 — *nǐ hǎo ma* — **how are you?**

Read it: the three known shapes from left to right
They are 你, 好, and the new 吗 on the end. Every one of them is a character you have already written.
That is the whole of what 吗 buys you. The book has been able to write 你好 since its first page and has never once been able to ask anything. One character, six strokes, and the greeting turns into a question.
Chinese built it from 你好 and 吗: *hǎo* is inherited from Middle Chinese *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and 吗 is usually traced, with some doubt, to *mju*, "not have".

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 你好吗 — keep the three characters the same size
吗 is not written smaller for meaning nothing.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.8 Retrieval 1 — greeting, or question?

Say **hello**, then **how are you**, and name the difference between them. Then say **book**, and recall your four scores from the primary-school payoff.

Your turn

Hear the two meanings in mixed order. Say each Mandarin answer, read its unpointed card, then write it. Look at the last character before deciding whether you were greeted or asked.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.9 Hear *shì ma* — is that so?

Say **to be**, then say **how are you**.

What to know first

shì ma — **is that so? really?**

Two syllables: the verb **to be**, falling hard, then the light question syllable. Nothing else.

This is the move you make when somebody tells you something and you want to show you heard it and to invite them to go on. English spends a whole phrase on it — *is that so*, *really*, *oh yes?* — and Mandarin spends two syllables, one of which you learned yesterday.

Say it with the voice going **down** on *shì* and staying light on *ma*. Said flat it checks a fact; said with the fall exaggerated it registers surprise.

Shì ma is built from *shì*, from Middle Chinese *dzyeX*, and the question particle *ma*.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.10 是吗 — checking what you were told

Say **is that so**. *Write it:* 是, finishing 日 before the lower body, then 书 and 中 as well

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

是吗 — *shì ma* — **is that so? really?**

Two known shapes, in the order you hear them: the nine-stroke 是, then the six-stroke 吗.
It is the shortest sentence in the book and it is a complete turn in a conversation. Somebody says something; you say 是吗; they keep going. Nothing about it is a fixed phrase to memorise — it is the yes-or-no rule applied to a one-word sentence.
Chinese built it from 是, inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and the question particle 吗, whose origin is not settled.

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 是吗 — leave a clear boundary between the two characters, and keep 是 the wider of the pair

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.11 Hear *hǎo bu hǎo* — the question with the answer inside it

Say **good**, say **not**, and say **is that so**.

What to know first

hǎo bu hǎo — **is it good? all right?**

Three syllables and no new word in any of them: **good**, **not**, **good**.

This is Mandarin's **second** way of asking a yes-or-no question, and it is completely unlike the first. Where *ma* adds a syllable that means nothing, this one says the word, then denies it, then says it again — and hands the listener both possible answers so they can pick one.

The **bu** in the middle goes light and toneless when it is caught between two copies of the same word. Say *hǎo-bu-hǎo* with the stress on the first and last and the middle syllable almost swallowed.

Both questions ask the same thing. *ma* is the neutral one; this one presses a little harder for a decision, which is why it is the one you hear at the end of a suggestion.

Hǎo bu hǎo is built from two words inherited from Middle Chinese: *xawX*, "good", and *pjut*, "not".

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.12 好不好 — the question that needed no new character

Say **is it good**. *Write it:* 好 and 不, keeping all four strokes of 不 separate

Say **secondary school**.

Grammar lens — say it, deny it, say it again

好不好 — *hǎo bu hǎo* — is it good? all right?

Three known shapes, and the pattern behind them works on anything:

- 是不是 — *shì bu shì* — is it, or isn't it?
- 看不看 — *kàn bu kàn* — will you look, or won't you?

Take any word that can be denied, put 不 in the middle, and repeat it. That is the whole rule, and it needs no new character because you have had 不 since the negation lesson.

Mandarin now gives you **two** ways to ask a yes-or-no question, and this book hands you both in this one chapter:

- 看书吗 — the light syllable on the end
- 看不看书 — the word, denied, and said again

They mean the same thing. Neither moves a word, and neither borrows a helper verb the way English does.
Both would be written with a question mark of Chinese's own at the end. That mark is not taught yet, so it is left off here.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好不好 is a Chinese pattern, not a borrowing: both words are inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX*, "good", and *pjut*, "not" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Write it: one copy of 好不好, then one more of your own — take a word you can write, put 不 in the middle, and write it again

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.13 Retrieval 2 — which question was that?

Say **how are you**, **is that so**, and **is it good**, in that order.
Then say **read a book**. *Write it:* 中学

Your turn

Hear the three meanings in mixed order. Say each Mandarin answer. *Read it:* each Mandarin form without pinyin

Decide which of the two question patterns each one uses — the light syllable on the end, or the word denied in the middle.

Write it: each one

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.14 Listening score — catch the question

Say the light syllable that turns a statement into a question, and say where it goes. *Read it:* 看书 and 看见 aloud

Your turn

No cards and no writing. Hear each of the three, six times over in mixed order, and say the English meaning aloud before the next one starts.

Score listening on its own. A miss here is not a reading miss and not a writing miss, and it is repaired by hearing the item again rather than by looking at it.

The light *ma* is the thing most often missed, because it is short, toneless and last. If you lose one, that is almost certainly the one.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.15 Reading score — no pinyin on the card

Write it: 吗 once from memory, then 是

Then say **secondary-school pupil**.

Your turn

Read it: the three cards cold — no pinyin is printed on any of them — and for each one, say it aloud, then give the English

Score reading on its own. Reading and hearing fail differently here: by ear the light *ma* is easy to lose, and on the page it is the most visible thing in the sentence because it is a whole character. The one you miss reading is more likely to be 好不好, where nothing is added and the clue is a repetition.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.16 Payoff — the book can ask

> Say **hello**, **to be**, **good**, **not**, and the light question syllable.
> *Write it:* 中学生

Your turn

Four passes over the same four items, scored separately:

- **Listening.** Hear each of the four and give its English.
- **Speaking.** Be given the English and say the Mandarin, tones and all.
- *Read it:* four unpointed cards cold, then give their meanings
- **Writing.** Hear each one. *Write it:* each one with no model

Record four numbers, not one. A reader who hears all four and writes none has a writing problem, and averaging the two hides it.

What you've built

Before this chapter the book had no way to ask a yes-or-no question at all. It could greet, name, count to five, say what it saw and say what it read, and it could not ask about any of it.
One character closed that, and it did more than its own weight: every statement this book has taught you is now also a question, because 吗 goes on the end of a finished sentence and changes nothing else. The second pattern, 好不好, needed no new character whatsoever — it is 不, which you have had for chapters, put between two copies of a word.

Before you move on

Source: Official HSK 3.0 syllabus, Level 1 vocabulary.

19.17 From cold, eight chapters on

> Close everything. The opening exchange of this book, both voices, from memory. If it came back without effort, that is the point of this page; if it did not, that is the point of this page.

You'll want to know: what a second pass is for

The first four exchanges were practised once, in the chapter that taught them, and not since. That is long enough ago to be a real test rather than a rehearsal:

greet	both voices, 你好
negate	answering that it is not so
identify	answering that it is
part	再见

Retrieval after a gap is what makes something stay. Running them again the week you learned them proves only that you had not yet forgotten.

Script and tone, the two that were taught once

女 + 子 → 好

Build 好 from its two halves without looking, then say it in both tones — *hǎo*, good, and *hào*, to be fond of. Two words, one set of six strokes, and the only thing separating them is the tone.

Your turn — four skills, on old material

- *Listen:* to a greeting and an answer, and say which of the two answers came back
- *Say it:* the greeting exchange, both voices
- *Read it:* 你好 and 再见, aloud, with nothing beside them
- *Write it:* 好, from its two halves, with the page covered

Before you move on

Which two halves build 好? (**女 and 子**.) What separates *hǎo* from *hào*? (**The tone alone.**) Which exchange closes a meeting? (**再见**.) And why is this page eight chapters after the material rather than beside it? (**Because retrieval after a gap is what makes it stay.**)

Chapter 20

Six to Ten, and the Character That Was Already Here

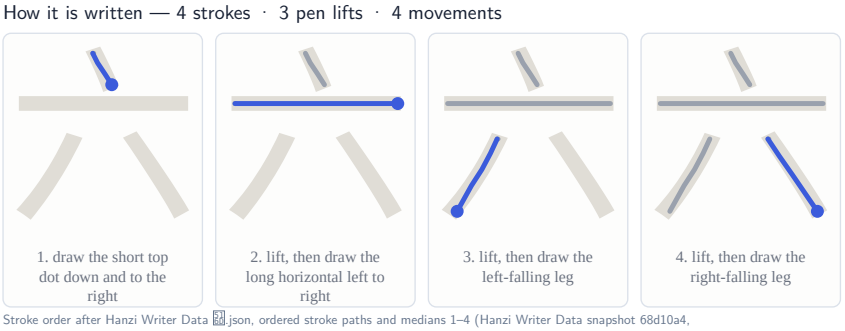
Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ✓ **pen** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 11 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say, hear, read and write the Mandarin numbers one to ten with their tones, and write the five characters this chapter adds.
>
> *Five characters and twelve strokes finish a run the book abandoned at five seventeen chapters earlier – with 八 set against 人, and 十 finally taught on its own after thirteen chapters inside 早.*

20.1 六 — four strokes again, for six this time

Write 五. How many strokes, and how many does it mean?

Script — a dot, a bar, two legs



How 六 is written, stroke by stroke

六

Four strokes. For six. 五 had four for five; 六 has four for six. Whatever was left of the counting trick after chapter 3 is now gone for good.

The four strokes, in order:

1. the short **diǎn** dot at the top centre, down and to the right
2. the long **héng** horizontal beneath it, left to right
3. the left leg, a **piě** falling to the lower left
4. the right leg, a **nà** falling to the lower right

Top before bottom, then left before right — the two rules that have ordered every character in this book.

Hold on to strokes 3 and 4. On their own, without the dot and the bar, they are the character for **eight**, and you will write them again in two lessons.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 六 — dot, bar, left leg, right leg
- *Cover:* write it again from memory

Before you move on

Sources: Hanzi Writer Data 六; Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.2 六 — six, and the run starts again

Write it: 六

Then count aloud to five.

The sounds and tones in this word

六 *liù* means **six**.
liù is **fourth tone** — the sharp fall, the same shape as *sì*, four. Say them together and only the mouth changes: **sì, liù**.
The vowel is worth a moment. Pinyin writes *iu*, and what you say is closer to *ioū*: there is a faint **o** in the middle that the spelling does not print.

What you've built — the run starts again

This book taught 一 二 三 四 五 in chapter 3 and then stopped. For seventeen chapters it could name a family, a school and a greeting and could not count to six — could not give an age, a price, a floor or a date. 六 is where that starts being paid back.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

六 *liù* is inherited from Middle Chinese *ljuwk*, "six", which lost its final *k* in Mandarin (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). It is usually compared with Tibetan *drug*, a likely Sino-Tibetan cognate.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **sì**, **liù** — one fall, twice
- **yī èr sān sì wǔ liù** — the run, at speed

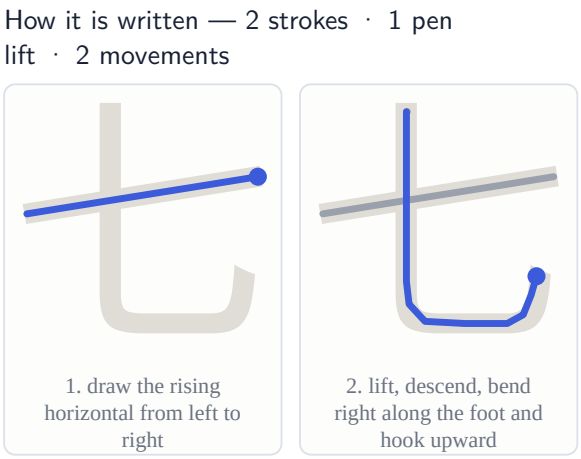
Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.3 七 — two strokes, for seven

Write 六 and say how many strokes it has.

Script — the second stroke does the work



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 45 65.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–2 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 七 is written, stroke by stroke

七

Two strokes. For seven. Six had four, seven has two — the stroke count is not merely useless now, it is running backwards.

The two strokes:

1. the **héng** horizontal, left to right, rising a little as it goes
2. the **shùwāngōu**: start high on the right, descend, bend along the foot to the right, and hook upward at the end

That second stroke is one continuous movement with two turns in it. Do not lift in the middle of it — a lift is what makes it two strokes instead of one, and seven would then be three.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 七 — the bar, then the turning stroke, unbroken
- *Count:* two strokes, not three

Before you move on

Sources: Hanzi Writer Data 七; Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.4 七 — seven

Write it: 七

Then say six.

The sounds and tones in this word

七 *qī* means **seven**.
qī is **first tone**, the high level one — the same shape as *yī*, one. Say them in a row and hold the pitch flat across both: **yī, qī**.
The **q** is the piece to work on, because English has no letter for it. Put the tongue where it goes for **y** in *yes*, then release the air the way you do for **ch**. It is not the *k* of *queen* and it is not an English *ch*; it is the tongue of one and the release of the other.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

七 *qī* is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshit*, "seven" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Mandarin turned its *tsh* into the *q* you are practising and dropped the final *t*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **yī**, **qī** — two high level tones

- **wǔ liù qī** — dip, fall, level

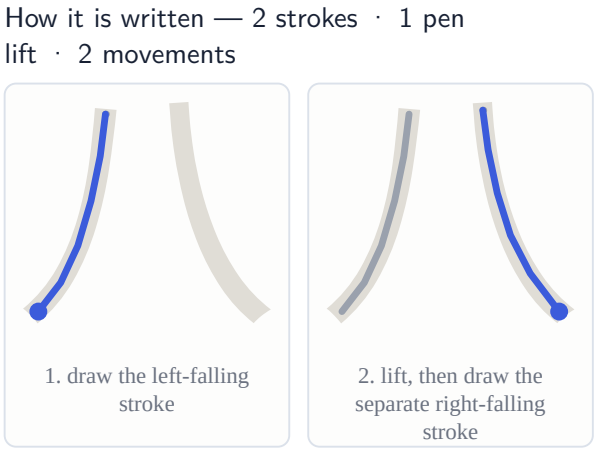
Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.5 八 — a character you have already written twice

Write 七, then write 六 and put a finger on its two legs.

Script — the gap is the character



How 八 is written, stroke by stroke

八

Two strokes. For eight.

1. the left leg, a **piě** falling to the lower left

2. lift, then the right leg, a **nà** falling to the lower right

You wrote both of them in 六 two lessons ago, under the dot and the bar. Take the dot and the bar away and what is left is eight.

And one more comparison, because it is the sharpest in the whole book: 人, *rén*, "person", is these same two strokes **joined at the top**. 八 is the same two strokes **parted**. The gap is the entire difference between a person and the number eight — which is why the first stroke of 八 begins below where 人's does, and why the two must never be allowed to touch.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 八 — left leg, lift, right leg, apart at the top
- *Contrast:* write 人 beside it and mark where they meet

Before you move on

Sources: Hanzi Writer Data 八; Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.6 八 — eight, and why it costs more

Write it: 八

Then say seven.

The sounds and tones in this word

八 *bā* means **eight**.
bā is **first tone**, high and level, like *qī*. The **b** is unaspirated: no puff of air, closer to an English *p* in *spin* than the *b* of *bin*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bā sounds close to *fā*, the first syllable of a word meaning to prosper or come into wealth. That resemblance is why eight is the number people pay extra for: on a car number plate, in a phone number, in the price of a flat on the eighth floor. The Beijing Olympics opened at eight seconds past eight on the eighth day of the eighth month.
A number can carry that much only in a language where numbers sound like other words, and this is the clearest case of it a beginner

will meet.
The word itself is inherited from Middle Chinese *peat*, "eight" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the luck rests on a likeness of sound, not on where the word comes from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **qī**, **bā** — two level tones
- **liù qī bā** — fall, level, level

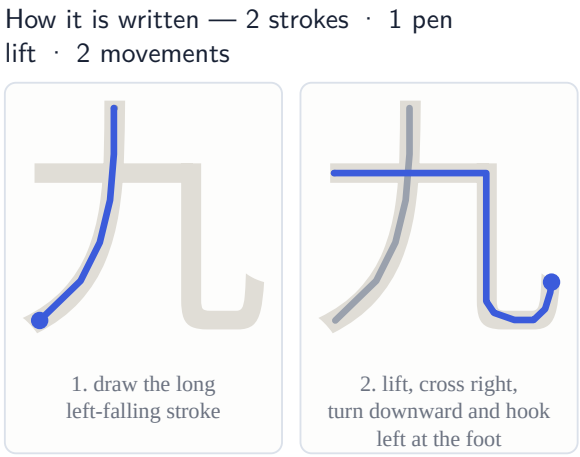
Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.7 九 — two strokes again

Write 八 and 七. How many strokes between them? Say why eight is the number people pay extra for.

Script — a fall and a turn



How 九 is written, stroke by stroke

九

Two strokes. For nine.

1. a long **piě**, falling from the upper right all the way to the lower left
2. lift, then the **héngzhéwāngōu**: cross the first stroke to the right, turn downward, and hook back to the left at the foot

Seven, eight and nine are two strokes each. **The last three single digits are the three quickest characters in this book to write**, and the three largest numbers you have. Whatever intuition said that bigger numbers need more ink is finished.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 九 — the long fall, then the crossing turn with its hook
- 七 八 九 in a row — six strokes for three numbers

Before you move on

Sources: Hanzi Writer Data 九; Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.8 九 — nine

Write it: 九

Then say eight.

The sounds and tones in this word

九 *jiǔ* means **nine**.
jiǔ is **third tone**, the low dip — so it joins *nǐ*, *hǎo* and *wǔ*. Say all four in a row and let the pitch stay low and creaky across every one.
The **j** is the unaspirated partner of the **q** in *qī*: same tongue position, no puff of air. Say **qī jiǔ** and the only difference is the breath.
Keep the dip in mind. Two third tones in a row do not both dip — the first one lifts — and nine is about to give this book its first pair of them.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

九 *jiǔ* is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjuwX*, "nine" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); Mandarin softened the *k* to *j*. It is usually compared with Tibetan *dgu*, a likely Sino-Tibetan cognate.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **nǐ hǎo wǔ jiǔ** — four dips
- **qī jiǔ** — the same tongue, one with breath and one without
- **qī bā jiǔ**

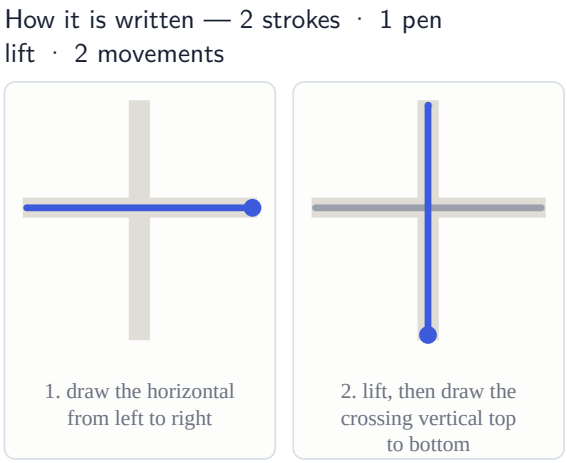
Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.9 十 — the character that was already here

Write 早, *zǎo*, morning. Say what sits under the sun in it.

Script — a bar and a post



How 十 is written, stroke by stroke

十

Two strokes. For ten.

1. the **héng** horizontal, left to right
2. lift, then the **shù** vertical, top to bottom, crossing it at the centre

You have written this before. It is the lower half of 早 — and the morning lesson said, in as many words, that on its own this piece is the character for ten, and then went on to something else. It has been sitting on the page for thirteen chapters waiting for a number to hang on.

Set it against 一, one: the same horizontal, with a post through it.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 十 — bar first, then post
- 早 and point at the 十 inside it

Before you move on

Sources: Hanzi Writer Data 十; Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.10 十 — ten

Write it: 十

Then say nine.

The sounds and tones in this word

十 *shí* means **ten**.
shí is **second tone**, the rise — the pitch starts in the middle and goes up, as if asking. It is the first number in the whole run of ten to use it. The **sh** curls the tongue back, further than an English *sh*. Keep the tip high and behind the ridge.
Say the whole run once: **yī èr sān sì wǔ liù qī bā jiǔ shí**. Level, fall, level, fall, dip, fall, level, level, dip, rise.

What you've built — the last of the ten

Ten is not simply the tenth word. It is the last one this book needs before **every number up to ninety-nine falls out of the ten it already has** — and the next chapter spends it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

十 *shí* is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyip*, "ten", whose final *p* Mandarin lost (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **bā jiǔ shí** — level, dip, rise
- the whole run, one to ten, at speed

Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

20.11 Payoff — one to ten

Say ten, then say why eight costs more.

Your turn

1. Count aloud one to ten, then ten to one.
2. Hear all ten named singly and out of order, and say each.
3. *Read it:* the ten characters printed shuffled — 九 三 十 六 一 八 四 七 二 五 — then say each with its tone
4. *Write it:* the five new ones from dictation — 六 七 八 九 十
5. Say the tone of each of the ten in order. Only one of them rises.
6. Say what 八 and 人 differ by, and what sits inside 早.

Five new characters cost **twelve strokes between them** — four, two, two, two and two. The single hardest thing in this chapter was not the writing; it was that the numbers had been left at five for seventeen chapters.

Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 21

Ten Words, Ninety-Nine Numbers

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build any number from eleven to ninety-nine out of the ten words I already have, say a hundred, and read a price written in Arabic numerals.
>
> *One rule of order turns ten words into ninety-nine numbers,* 一百 *is where* 一*'s tone finally moves, and the digits chapter says which of 5 and* 五 *a price tag actually prints.*

21.1 十一 — eleven, and the teens in one line

Count one to ten, then say ten on its own.

You'll want to know first — ten, then one

十一 — *shíyī* — **eleven**

Ten, then one. That is all of it.

And it does not stop at eleven. 十五 is *shíwǔ*, ten-five, fifteen. 十九 is *shíjiǔ*, ten-nine, nineteen. English has *eleven*, *twelve*, *thirteen* — three separate shapes before the pattern starts — and German, Russian and Urdu each have their own nine irregular words to memorise here.

Mandarin has none. The teens are the numbers you already have, in the order you already say them. Nine numbers, no new vocabulary, no new characters, and nothing to learn but the order.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

十一 is a Chinese formation, ten and one, and both pieces are inherited from Middle Chinese: *dzyip*, "ten", and *'jit*, "one" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

- *Say it:* **shíyī** — eleven
- *Build:* **shí** + **sān** → **shísān**, thirteen
- *Build:* **shí** + **bā** → **shíbā**, eighteen
- *Run through:* eleven to nineteen, straight through

Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

21.2 二十 — twenty, and ninety-nine numbers from ten words

Say **shíyī**, and build seventeen.

You'll want to know first — turn the pair round

二十 — *èrshí* — **twenty**

十一 is ten-one, eleven. 二十 is two-ten, twenty. The same two words in the other order, and the order is the entire difference.

That gives every ten: 三十 thirty, 四十 forty, 九十 ninety. Put a unit on the end of one and you have everything between: 二十一, *èrshíyī*, twenty-one; 九十九, ninety-nine.

Ten words reach ninety-nine. English needs *eleven*, *twelve* and *thirteen* before its own pattern begins, and *twenty*, *thirty* and *fifty* are three more shapes again. Mandarin needs none of them.

The sounds and tones in this word

九十九, ninety-nine, looks like a drill for the rule you met with *nǐ hǎo*, and it is a drill for when that rule does not fire. *jiǔ* is third tone and so is the *jiǔ* at the end, but 十 *shí* stands between them, and it is second tone. A third tone lifts into a rise only before another third tone. Say it: **jiǔ-shí-jiǔ**. Both nines dip.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

二十 is a Chinese formation, two tens, made of words inherited from Middle Chinese: *nyijH*, "two", and *dzyip*, "ten" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

- *Say it:* **èrshí** — twenty
- *Build:* **sān** + **shí** → **sānshí**, thirty
- *Build:* **wǔ** + **shí** + **liù** → **wǔshíliù**, fifty-six
- *Say it:* **jiǔshíjiǔ** — ninety-nine, both nines dipping

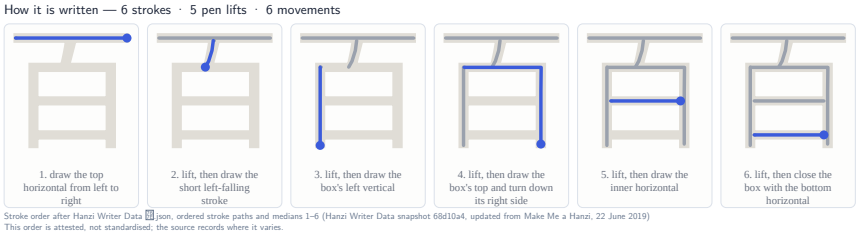
Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

21.3 百 — a hundred, on a box you have built before

Write 四 and 一.

Script — six strokes, five of them familiar



How 百 is written, stroke by stroke

百

Six strokes. For a hundred.

1. the top **héng** horizontal, left to right
2. lift, then the short **piě** below it, falling to the left
3. lift, then the **shù** vertical down the left side of the box
4. lift, then the **héngzhé**: across the top of the box and down its right side
5. lift, then the inner **héng** horizontal
6. lift, then the bottom **héng**, closing the box

Strokes 3 to 6 are the box of 四, built in the same order: the left side, then the top-and-right turn, then the inside, then the floor. **Outside before inside, and the box closes last** — the rule you used for 四 and 口.

Only strokes 1 and 2 are new, and stroke 1 is 一.

Your turn

Write these out:

- 百 — bar, short fall, then the box in 四's order
- 四 beside it and mark the four strokes they share

Before you move on

Sources: Hanzi Writer Data 百; Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

21.4 一百 — a hundred, and 一 moves

Write it: 百

Then say twenty.

The sounds and tones in this word

百 *bǎi* means **a hundred**, and it is almost always said with 一 in front of it: 一百, one hundred.
bǎi is **third tone**, the low dip, like *jiǔ* and *wǔ*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Counting on its own, 一 is **yī**, high and level. In 一百 it is not: you say **yìbǎi**, with a fall.
一 shifts its tone depending on what follows, exactly as 不 does — the behaviour this book named in its first chapter for a different word. Before a first, second or third tone, 一 falls: **yìbǎi**. Before a fourth tone it rises instead.
So the number that sounds simplest in the run is the one that changes most, and a hundred is where a learner meets it first.
Both words are inherited from Middle Chinese: *ʾjit*, "one", and *paek*, "hundred" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

- *Say it:* **yī** alone — level
- *Say it:* **yìbǎi** — falling, then dipping
- *Run through:* **shí, èrshí, yìbǎi** — ten, twenty, a hundred

Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

21.5 5 and 五 — the same number, two registers

Say five, then say a hundred.

You'll want to know first — where each one is written

5 and 五 are both *wǔ*.

A reader who has spent this chapter learning 六 七 八 九 十 could still walk past a Chinese shop and read nothing on the price tag, because **a price is written in Arabic numerals**. So are dates, telephone numbers, bus numbers, floor numbers, addresses and the year.

The characters are not archaic. They are a different register, and both are current:

written with	where you meet it
5, **20**, **100**	prices, dates, phone numbers, addresses, anything counted
五, 二十, 一百	formal and legal text, cheque amounts, shop signs, set phrases, running prose

Both are read aloud **the same way** — you see **5** and you say *wǔ*. That is the useful part: the digits cost you nothing to learn and everything to ignore.

One convention worth carrying: on a bill or a cheque an amount is often written twice, once in digits and once in characters, because the characters are much harder to alter.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

The digits are the Hindu-Arabic numerals, devised in India and carried west through Arabic; they came into everyday Chinese use only in modern times. 五 is the inherited word, from Middle Chinese *nguX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

- *Read it:* **5**, **10**, **20**, **99** aloud as *wǔ*, *shí*, *èrshí*, *jiǔshíjiǔ*
- *Write it:* each of those four in characters as well
- *Say it:* which of the two a price tag uses, and which a cheque uses

Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

21.6 Payoff — ninety-nine numbers, and the price tag

Count one to ten, then say which of **5** and 五 a price tag uses.

Your turn

1. **Build, do not recall.** Say twelve, seventeen, thirty, forty-five, sixty-eight and eighty-one, from the ten words alone.
2. Say **jiǔshíjiǔ**, ninety-nine. 十 between the two 九 is second tone, so the first 九 keeps its low dip: the dip lifts only before another third tone.
3. Say **yìbǎi**, and say what happens to 一 in front of it.
4. *Read it:* **8**, **15**, **30**, **99** and **100** off a page, then say each aloud
5. *Write it:* 十一, 二十 and 一百 in characters
6. Give a floor number, an age and a price, each as a bare number.

Count what this cost: **five characters and one rule of order** — ten before a unit multiplies nothing, ten after a unit multiplies it. That order is worth more than every word in this chapter put together.

What is still out of reach: *yìqiān*, a thousand, and everything above it — and the measure word a Chinese number needs before an actual noun, which is a chapter of its own.

Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

21.7 Close the numeral slice

Count one to ten, then say why eight costs more.

Your turn

The six new characters, alone, from spoken cues and with no number around them: 六 七 八 九 十 百.

Then put each back to work once.

1. *Write it:* the five single digits, and say the stroke count of each — four, two, two, two, two; twelve strokes for five numbers
2. *Write it:* 百, and mark the four strokes it shares with 四
3. *Write it:* 早, and mark the 十 inside it
4. *Write it:* 人 and 八 side by side, and say what separates them
5. Build six numbers between eleven and ninety-nine from the ten words.
6. *Read it:* a price in digits, then say it aloud in words

Say what the whole slice cost the hand: **six characters, fourteen strokes**, and one rule about the order of two of them.

Before you move on

Source: Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart

Chapter 22

The Grammar That Is Not There

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can state the four things Mandarin does not do — no verb endings, no agreement, no article, no separate nationality word — and name where somebody is from.

Four facts about Mandarin's shape and one join, and the whole chapter adds not a single character: three of the four are things a reader must stop doing, and the fourth puts 中国 *and* 人 *together for the first time.*

22.1 看 — the verb that never changes

A new chapter, and it teaches no new character at all. Five retrievals first.

- *Recall:* say *liù qī bā jiǔ shí bǎi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *bǎi* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *zì — hànzì — hànyǔ — zhōngwén — zhōngguó* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *yǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *hànyǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

You'll want to know: there is nothing to conjugate

> **A Mandarin verb has exactly one form. It never changes — not for who is doing it, not for how many of them there are, and not for when.**

You have been given 看 *kàn*, "to look", and you have used it in exactly one shape. That was not the lesson being brief. That is the whole verb.

我看书	*wǒ kàn shū* — I read
你看书	*nǐ kàn shū* — you read
人看书	*rén kàn shū* — people read

The verb is 看 three times. Nothing has been added, dropped or swapped.

This is worth stating out loud because of what a reader coming from English or Spanish does otherwise: they wait for the ending, decide the book has not reached it yet, and go on quietly expecting one. Spanish has *hablo, hablas, habla, hablamos, habláis, hablan.* English has three forms and an irregular verb for every occasion. **Mandarin has one shape and no exceptions.**

Every verb in this book behaves this way — 看, 是, 上学 — and so will every verb in every chapter after it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *wǒ kàn shū*, *nǐ kàn shū*, *rén kàn shū* — one verb, three sentences
- 我是学生 / 你是学生 — 是 does not move either

Before you move on

How many forms does a Mandarin verb have? (**One**.) What changes when the person changes? (**Nothing**.) And what should you stop waiting for? (**The ending** — there is not one.)

22.2 我是 — nothing agrees with anything

One lesson back, and the same fact from the other end.

- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *yìbǎi* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kànjiàn* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *yǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *hànzì* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

You'll want to know: the subject changes nothing

> **The subject of a Mandarin sentence has no effect on the verb whatsoever.**

The last lesson said a verb has one form. This says the other half: nothing about the subject reaches it.

> 我是学生 *wǒ shì xuésheng* — I am a student. 你是学生 *nǐ shì xuésheng* — you are a student. 人是学生 *rén shì xuésheng* — people are students.

是 *shì* is the same 是 in all three. An English speaker has to pick *am*, *are* or *is*; a Spanish speaker has to pick *soy*, *eres*, *es*, *somos*, *sois* or *son*. You pick 是.

Grammar Lens: and nothing after the verb agrees either

The thing that comes AFTER 是 does not change either.

> 我是大学生 — I am a university student. 人是大学生 — people are university students.

大学生 is one word with one shape whether it names one person or a hundred. Spanish would need *estudiante* against *estudiantes*, and would then need the adjective to follow suit. Mandarin marks none of it.

So the whole of agreement, in Mandarin, is a thing you must not do. That is an unusual kind of lesson: what a Spanish learner

spends months getting right, a Mandarin learner has to be told to stop attempting. If you find yourself wondering which form to use, the answer is that there is only one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我是学生 — 你是学生 — 人是学生
- 我是大学生 — 人是大学生 — one shape, one and many

Before you move on

What does the subject do to the verb? (**Nothing**.) What does a plural subject do to the noun after 是? (**Nothing** — 大学生 has one shape.) So how much agreement is there in Mandarin? (**None at all**.)

22.3 书 — a book, the book, books

Two lessons in, and this one is about a word you have had since the reading chapter.

- *Recall:* say *wǒ shì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǔ* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kànjiàn* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎokàn* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *yǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *hàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

You'll want to know: Mandarin has no article

> 书 *shū* means **a book**, **the book**, and **books**. Mandarin has no word for *a* and no word for *the*, and a bare noun says nothing about how many there are.

Which of the three it means is settled by what is going on around it, and by nothing in the word itself.

> 我看书 — I read *a* book. / I read *the* book. / I read books.

All three are the same sentence. If you need to say **one** book you can count it — that takes a measure word, which arrives in two chapters. If you need to say **this** book you can point at it, which needs a word this book has not taught yet. What you never need is an article, because there is not one to leave out.

This is the trap for an English or Spanish speaker, and it runs both ways. Arriving, they hunt for the missing *the* and try to supply it from their own language. Leaving, they drop English articles: *I read book.* Neither is a vocabulary problem. Mandarin does not mark the distinction here at all, and 书 on its own is complete.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我看书 — and mean it three ways
- 书 — a book, the book, books

Before you move on

What does 书 mean? (**A book, the book, and books** — all three.) How does Mandarin mark which one? (**It does not.**) What should an English speaker stop looking for? (**The article** — there is none.)

22.4 中国人 — where somebody is from

> The fourth lesson of a chapter that has added no character at all.

- *Recall:* say *shū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *shíyī èrshí jiǔshíjiǔ yìbǎi* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎokàn* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shū* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *hànyǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *hànzì* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

You'll want to know: country plus 人

中国人 *Zhōngguó rén* — **a Chinese person**.

Read it: 中国人 again and count what is new

中国 *Zhōngguó*, China, was taught in the country chapter. 人 *rén*, person, was the first character this book ever asked you to write. **Nothing here is new. The lesson is the join.**

我是中国人 *wǒ shì Zhōngguó rén* — I am Chinese. 你是中国人吗 *nǐ shì Zhōngguó rén ma* — are you Chinese?

That second sentence uses 吗 from the asking chapter, and it is one of the two or three questions a beginner is asked most often.

Grammar Lens: the rule, and how far it reaches

country + 人 = a person from that country.

That is the whole pattern, and it works on every country name without exception. Mandarin has no separate set of nationality words the way English has *China* → *Chinese*, *Spain* → *Spanish*, *France* → *French*, each with its own shape to learn. It has one noun and one suffix.

The same trick makes the language name, with 语 or 文 instead of 人 — and you already hold both: 汉语 and 中文 were taught in the language chapters. So one country word gives you the place, the people and the language.

Notice what Mandarin does **not** do here. It does not capitalise 中国人,

because it has no capitals at all. It does not agree the word with anything. And it does not distinguish *a Chinese person* from *Chinese people*: 中国人 is both.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 中国人 — *Zhōngguó rén*
- 我是中国人
- 你是中国人吗

Before you move on

How do you say "a Chinese person"? (中国人.) How many new characters did that take? (**None** — 中国 and 人 were both already yours.) What is the rule? (**Country plus 人**.)

22.5 中国人 — 书 — 看: the chapter with no new character

The chapter closes. Five retrievals, then the four skills.

- *Recall:* say *Zhōngguó rén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *liù qī bā jiǔ shí bǎi* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shū* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kànshū* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì* — *hànzì* — *hànyǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *zì* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

What you've built — four facts, no new strokes

A character costs this book a great deal: a stroke record checked against a source, a writing lesson, a reading lesson, and a regeneration of the font the book prints with. **This chapter cost none of that**, and it is worth saying what it bought.

1. **A verb has one form.** 我看书, 你看书, 人看书.
2. **Nothing agrees.** Not the verb with its subject, not what follows 是 with how many there are.
3. **There is no article.** 书 is a book, the book, and books.
4. **Country + 人 names a people.** 我是中国人

Three of those four are things you must *stop* doing rather than start, which is why no lesson had ever said them: an absence leaves no word to teach. The fourth is a join between two things the book had already given you and never let meet.
Listen. *Wǒ shì Zhōngguó rén. Nǐ ne — nǐ shì Zhōngguó rén ma?*
Speak. Say what you are, and ask the same question back with 吗.
Read it: 我是中国人 — 你是中国人吗
Write it: 中国人 — every stroke of it is one you have written before

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我是中国人
- *Say it:* 你是中国人吗
- *Write it:* 中国人

Before you move on

Name the four facts this chapter taught. (**One verb form; no agreement; no article; country plus 人.**) How many characters did it add? (**None.**) And which of the four is a thing to start doing rather than stop? (**Country plus 人.**)

Chapter 23

De — The Hinge

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say whose something is, put a whole description in front of the noun it describes, and open a sentence with its topic.
>
> *One character, eight strokes and no tone, doing three jobs — and the third of them, the topic slot, costs no character at all because it is an order rather than a word.*

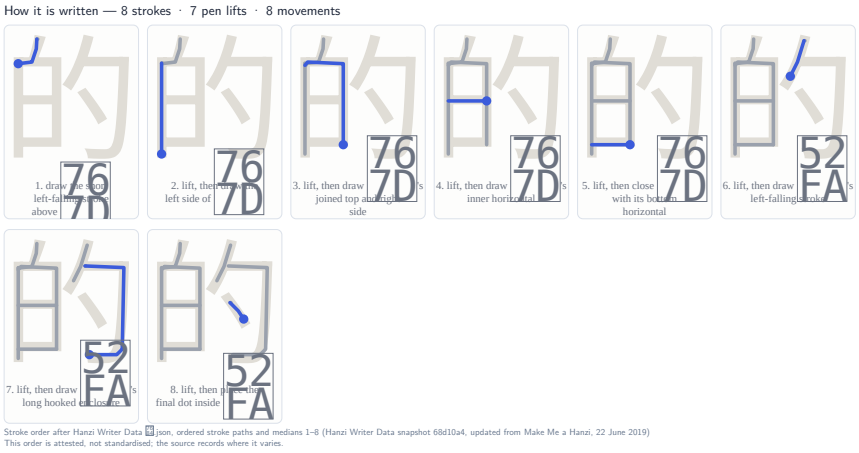
23.1 的 — eight strokes for the commonest character there is

A new chapter. Six retrievals, then the pen.

- *Recall:* say *Zhōngguó rén — shū — kàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kànshū* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kàn — kànjiàn — hǎokàn — shū — kànshū* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì — hànzì — hànyǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more

- *Recall:* say *zhōngxué* — *zhōngxuésheng* — *tóngxué* — *shàngxué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — a box on the left, a hook on the right



How 的 is written, stroke by stroke

的

Eight strokes, in two halves. The left half is 白 *bái*, "white"; the right half is 勺 *sháo*, a ladle. Finish the whole left half before the right one starts — the rule every two-part character in this book has followed.

The left half, 白, five strokes:

1. a short **piě** falling to the left, at the top
2. the **shù** down the left side of the box
3. the **héngzhé** across the top and down the right side, without lifting
4. the **héng** inside the box
5. the **héng** that closes its floor

That box is built exactly as 百's was, and for the same reason: **outside before inside, and the floor last.**

The right half, 勺, three strokes:

1. a **piě** falling to the left from the top
2. a long **héngzhégōu** down the right side, hooking left at the base
3. a single **diǎn** dot, placed last, inside the enclosure

The dot goes in last. Enclose, then fill. That is why it is stroke eight and not stroke six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 的 — 白 first, all five, then 勺's three
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and check the dot came last

Before you move on

How many strokes does 的 have, and how do they split? (**Eight** — five for 白, three for 勺.) Which stroke is the dot? (**The last one** — enclose, then fill.) Which character built its box the same way? (百.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 的, pinned stroke paths and medians.

23.2 的 — whose it is

One lesson back, and the character is already under your pen.

- *Recall:* say *de* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǒ shì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ma* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zhōngwén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *shàngxué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

The sounds and tones in this word

的 is said **de** — and that is the whole of it. **No tone at all.**
It is the third toneless word in this book, after 吗 and the 上 of 早上, and like them it is said light, short and low, leaning on the word in front of it. Do not give it a falling tone because it looks like a full character. It is a hinge, not a word.

Grammar Lens: owner + 的 + owned

owner + 的 + the thing owned.

我的书 *wǒ de shū* — my book 我的名字 *wǒ de míngzi* — my name 你的书 *nǐ de shū* — your book

That is the entire Mandarin possessive. Look at what is NOT there:

- **No agreement.** 的 never changes for the owner, the thing, or how many.
- **No separate word for "mine".** English needs *my* and *mine*; Spanish needs *mi*, *mío*, *mía*, *míos*, *mías*. Mandarin has 的.
- **No difference between one owner and several.** The same 的 does both.

You have had 我 since the chapter that taught you to say who you are, and it has had nothing to own until now.
One habit worth learning early: with family and with very close things, Mandarin **drops** 的 — a speaker says 我家, not 我的家. The closer the tie, the likelier the 的 falls away.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

的 is a borrowed spelling. The character's own Middle Chinese reading is *tek*, "bright; a target"; the particle is usually traced to a Tang-period particle written with another character, read *tejX*. The details are not settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *wǒ de shū* — 我的书
- *wǒ de míngzi* — 我的名字
- *nǐ de shū* — 你的书

Before you move on

What tone does 的 carry? (**None**.) What is the order? (**Owner, 的, thing owned**.) And what does 的 do when the owner is plural? (**Nothing** — it never changes.)

23.3 看书的人 — the one who reads

One lesson back, and the same character doing a bigger job.

- *Recall:* say *de* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *shū* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ma* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *nǐ hǎo ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *wén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *shàngxué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Grammar Lens: put the description in front

的 does not only join an owner to a thing. Put a whole clause in front of it and that clause describes the noun that follows.

> 看书的人 *kàn shū de rén* — the person **who reads books**
> 看书的学生 — the student **who reads books** 我看的书 *wǒ kàn de shū* — the book **I read**

Set the Mandarin order against the English. English says *the person who reads books*: noun first, description trailing after it. Mandarin says *reads-books* 的 *person*: **description first, noun last,**

always.
That is the single most important thing in this lesson, and it is not a word to learn — it is a direction to turn round. Everything that describes a noun in Mandarin goes in front of it, however long it gets, and 的 is the hinge that holds it there. English has one construction like this and it is short — *a well-read person* — and Mandarin uses that shape for all of them.
Notice that the 的 is the same 的 as the last lesson's, unchanged and toneless. Mandarin does not have one word for the possessive and another for the relative. It has this one hinge, and what goes in front of it decides which job it is doing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kàn shū de rén* — 看书的人
- *wǒ kàn de shū* — 我看的书
- 看书的学生

Before you move on

Where does a Mandarin description go? (**In front of the noun**, always.) Which word holds it there? (的.) Is it a different 的 from 我的书? (**No** — one hinge, two jobs.)

23.4 汉语 — 我看书: topic first, comment after

Four in, and this one names the shape the whole language prefers.

- *Recall:* say *kàn shū de rén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *Zhōngguó rén* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *nǐ hǎo ma* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shì ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance

- *Recall:* say *wén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *tóngxué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Grammar Lens: the topic comes first

Mandarin puts the thing being talked about first, and then says something about it. The first slot is the TOPIC, not necessarily the subject.

汉语 — 我看书 *Hànyǔ, wǒ kàn shū* — Chinese? I read it. 书 — 我看 *shū, wǒ kàn* — Books, I read. 我 — 中国人 *wǒ, Zhōngguó rén* — Me, I'm Chinese.

(Chinese writes a comma at that seam. This book has not taught a single punctuation mark — its own inventory reports the column empty — so the seam is printed here as a dash rather than smuggled in.)
In each of those the first word is not doing the verb. It is the subject *under discussion*, and the rest of the sentence is the remark about it. English can do this and treats it as informal — *me, I'd rather walk*; *that book, I've read*. Mandarin does it constantly and treats it as ordinary. It is why so much beginner Mandarin built on an English template sounds stiff: the learner keeps the doer in front when a Mandarin speaker would have put the topic there.
A useful consequence. Once the topic is set, everything afterwards can leave it out. A Mandarin speaker will not repeat 书 in the second half of *shū, wǒ kàn* — and will not supply a pronoun for it either. Where English needs *it*, Mandarin needs nothing, because the topic is still standing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 汉语 — 我看书
- 书 — 我看
- 我 — 中国人

Before you move on

What goes in the first slot of a Mandarin sentence? (**The topic** — what is being talked about.) Must it be the one doing the verb? (**No**.) What does the second half do about repeating it? (**Nothing** — it leaves it out.)

23.5 我的书 — 看书的人

The chapter closes on one character and the four skills.

- *Recall:* say *Hànyǔ, wǒ kàn shū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *Zhōngguó rén — shū — kàn* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shì ma* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎo bu hǎo* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *wén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *tóng* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

What you've built — the hinge

One character, eight strokes, no tone — and with it:

1. 我的书 — whose something is, with no agreement anywhere.
2. 看书的人 — a description standing in FRONT of what it describes.
3. 汉语 — 我看书 — a topic first, and a comment after it.

The third of those needed no character at all: it is an order, not a word. It is in this chapter because 的 is what makes the first slot worth filling.
Listen. *Wǒ de shū. Kàn shū de rén. Hànyǔ, wǒ kàn shū.*
Speak. Say whose the book is, then say who the reader is.

Read it: 我的名字 — 看书的学生 — 书 — 我看
Write it: 的 — 白 first, then 勺, and the dot last

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我的书 — 我的名字 — 你的书
- *Say it:* 看书的人 — 看书的学生
- *Write it:* 的

Before you move on

Name the three jobs this chapter gave 的 and its slot. (**Possession; a description in front of its noun; and the topic that opens a sentence**.) Which one cost no character? (**The topic** — it is an order, not a word.)

Chapter 24

Have, and Count

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

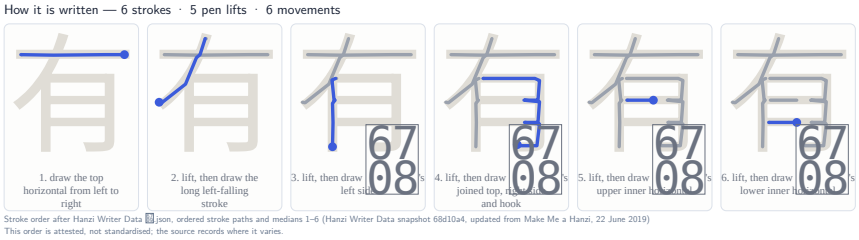
> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I have, say that there is something, and put a number against a noun with a measure word between them.
>
> *Nine strokes across two characters give the numerals something to count at last, and* 个 *is three strokes of which two are* 人.

24.1 有 — six strokes, and a moon underneath

A new chapter, and its first character is a verb the book has gone twenty-three chapters without.

- *Recall:* say *wǒ de shū — kàn shū de rén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *de* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎo bu hǎo* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ma — nǐ hǎo ma — shì ma — hǎo bu hǎo* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zhōngwén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *tóngxué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — two strokes on top, 月 beneath



How 有 *is written, stroke by stroke*

有

Six strokes. Two cross at the top; the remaining four build 月, the moon, underneath.

1. the **héng** across the top, left to right
2. the long **piě** from the top centre, falling to the lower left and running past everything below it

Horizontal before left-falling. You have written that order twice already, in 大 and in 六, and it decides these two.

Then 月:

1. the **shù** down the left side
2. the **héngzhégōu** across the top and down the right side, hooking left at the base — one stroke, two turns, no lift
3. the upper **héng** inside it
4. the lower **héng** inside it

Enclose, then fill: the two inner bars come after the walls, exactly as in 白 and 百 and 四.

One thing to watch. Stroke 2 is the longest in the character and it must reach the bottom-left corner, well past 月. A short one turns 有 into something that is not 有.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 有 — bar, long fall, then 月's four
- *Cover:* write it again, and check the long stroke reaches the corner

Before you move on

How many strokes does 有 have? (**Six**.) Which comes first, the horizontal or the falling stroke? (**The horizontal** — as in 大 and 六.) What sits underneath? (月, built walls-first.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 有, pinned stroke paths and medians.

24.2 有 — to have, and there is

One lesson back, and the character is already yours.

- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *de* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *liù* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *liù* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì* — *hànzì* — *hànyǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *xiǎo* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

The sounds and tones in this word

有 *yǒu* is **third tone** — the dip, low and creaky, the same shape as the 好 you have said since your first day and the 五 you count with. Say them in a row and only the mouth changes: **hǎo, wǔ, yǒu.**

我有书 *wǒ yǒu shū* — I have a book. 我有名字 — I have a name.

Grammar Lens: the same verb says there is

有 is also how Mandarin says **there is** and **there are**. It is one verb doing both jobs, and no extra word is needed for the second:

> 有人 *yǒu rén* — there is somebody. / somebody's here. 有中国人 — there are Chinese people here.

English needs *have* for the first job and *there is* for the second; Spanish needs *tener* and *hay*. Mandarin needs 有.
And now the exception that every Mandarin course states early, because it is the only one of its kind:

> **有 is the one verb 不 cannot negate.**

不 has negated everything in this book so far — 不好, 不是, 不谢 — and it cannot negate this. The negative of 有 is *méi yǒu*, said with a different negator altogether, whose character this book has not yet taught. Hold the rule now and the writing later: **不有 is never Mandarin.**

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

有 *yǒu* is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjuwX*, "to have; to exist" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); both of its jobs are old ones.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hǎo, wǔ, yǒu* — three dips
- 我有书 我有名字
- 有人

Before you move on

What tone is 有? (**Third**, the dip.) What are its two jobs? (**To have**, and **there is**.) Which negator does it refuse? (不 — 有 takes *méi* instead.)

24.3 个 — three strokes, and you already write two of them

Two lessons in, and this character is nearly free.

- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *kàn shū de rén* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *qī* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *qī* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zhōngguó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *dà* — *dàjiā* — *xué* — *xuésheng* — *dàxué* — *dàxuésheng* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — 人, and a line under it

Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 个.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 个 is written, stroke by stroke

个

Three strokes, and the first two are a character you have written since the opening chapter.

1. the **piě**, falling from the peak to the lower left
2. the **nà**, falling from the same peak to the lower right
3. the **shù**, straight down from under the junction

Strokes 1 and 2 are 人 — the same pair, from the same peak, in the same order. All that is new is a vertical hung beneath it.

Keep the roof wide and the vertical dead centre. If the roof narrows, 个 starts to look like 人 with an accident underneath.

This is the cheapest character in the chapter and it does the most work in the one after it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 人 — then 个, which is 人 with a line under it
- *Cover:* write 个 from memory

Before you move on

How many strokes does 个 have? (**Three**.) Which character are the first two? (人.) And the third? (**A vertical, straight down from the junction**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 个, pinned stroke paths and medians.

24.4 个 — the word that goes between a number and a thing

One lesson back, and this is what the numerals were for.

- *Recall:* say *gè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *Hànyǔ, wǒ kàn shū* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *bā* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *bā* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance

- *Recall:* say *guó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *dàxuésheng* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Grammar Lens: number + 个 + noun

In Mandarin a number cannot touch a noun. Something has to stand between them, and 个 is the one that fits almost everything.

Wrong: 三人 **Right:** 三个人 *sān ge rén* — three people **Right:** 一个学生 *yí ge xuésheng* — one student **Right:** 五个名字 — five names

You have been able to count to ninety-nine since the last chapter and there has been nothing to count. This is the missing piece, and it is one character.
English does this in a few places and does not notice: *three **head** of cattle*, *two **slices** of bread*, *a **pair** of trousers*. Mandarin does it **every time**, for every noun, without exception.

The sounds and tones in this word

个 is *gè*, **fourth tone** — the sharp fall, the same shape as 四 and 六. But in the middle of a count it usually goes **light and toneless**: *sān ge rén*, not *sān gè rén*. It behaves the way 吗 and 的 do — a small word leaning on its neighbours.
And one sandhi you already own comes back here. 一 is first tone alone, and before a fourth-tone syllable it rises: 一个 is *yí ge*, not *yī ge*. That is the same tone change the hundred lesson taught on 一百.
Mandarin has dozens of measure words, each tied to a shape or a kind of thing, and 个 is the general-purpose one. Use 个 when you do not know which is right, and you will be understood every time.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

个 is inherited from Middle Chinese *kaH*, "a single piece".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sān ge rén* — 三个人
- *yí ge xuésheng* — 一个学生
- 五个名字

Before you move on

What has to stand between a number and a noun? (**A measure word** — 个 fits almost everything.) What is wrong with 三人? (**Nothing stands between the number and the noun**.) How is 一个 said? (***Yí ge*** — 一 rises before a fourth tone.)

24.5 我有一个名字

The chapter closes with the sentence its two characters were for.

- *Recall:* say *gè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǒ de shū — kàn shū de rén* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *jiǔ* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *jiǔ* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *guó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *dàxué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

What you've built — have, and count

Two characters this chapter, nine strokes between them, and here is the sentence they buy:

我有一个名字 *wǒ yǒu yí ge míngzi* — I have a name.

Everything in it except 有 and 个 was already yours: 我 from the chapter where you said who you were, 一 from the counting chapter, 名字 from the naming one. The chapter did not add a sentence; it added the two words that let the sentence exist.

And the same nine strokes give:

> 有人 — there is somebody. 三个学生 — three students. 我有一个中国名字 — I have a Chinese name.

Listen. *Wǒ yǒu yí ge míngzi. Yǒu rén. Sān ge xuésheng.*
Speak. Say what you have; then count three of something.
Read it: 我有一个名字 — 有人 — 三个学生
Write it: 有 — bar, long fall, 月; 个 — 人, then a line

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我有一个名字
- *Say it:* 有人 三个学生
- *Write it:* 有 个

Before you move on

Say "I have a name." (我有一个名字.) What does 有 do besides *have*? (**It says *there is*.**) And why can 三 not sit straight against 人? (**A number needs a measure word** — 三个人.)

Chapter 25

Le — Finished, and Changed

Modes: **voice** (4) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

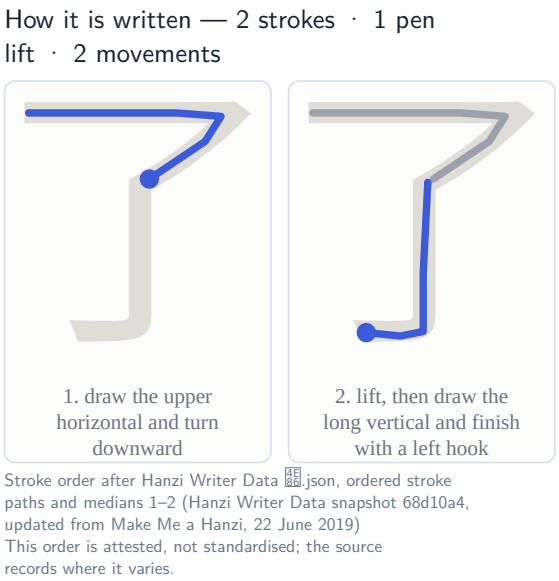
> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that an action is finished, that a situation has changed, and explain why neither of those is a tense.
>
> *Two strokes — fewer than any character in the book but* 一 *and* 二 *— and with them the first sentences in this track that are not happening now.*

25.1 了 — two strokes

A new chapter, and the smallest character in it does the most.

- *Recall:* say *wǒ yǒu yí ge míngzi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shí* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shí* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *guó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *sheng* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — a turn, and a hook



How 了 is written, stroke by stroke

了

Two strokes. Only 一 and 二 have used fewer.

1. the **héngpiě**: start with a short flat run at the upper left, then let it fall away to the right — **one stroke, one turn, no lift**

2. the **shùgōu**: lift, come down from under that turn almost to the floor of the square, and flick left at the very end

The hook at the foot is not decoration; it is what tells 了 apart from a bare vertical. Finish it.

You have written a **héngzhé** — a horizontal that turns down — in every 口 since the fourth chapter. This is its cousin: the turn does not go straight down, it falls away.

Two strokes, and no tone. For a character that carries more grammar than any other in this book, it asks remarkably little of the hand.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 了 — the turn, then the hooked vertical
- *Cover:* write it again, and check the hook is there

Before you move on

How many strokes does 了 have? (**Two**.) Which characters use fewer? (**一 and 二**.) What must the second stroke end with? (**A hook to the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 了, pinned stroke paths and medians.

25.2 我看了书 — the thing is done

One lesson back, and the character is already under your pen.

- *Recall:* say *le* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *yī èr sān sì wǔ liù qī bā jiǔ shí* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shíyī* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zhōngguó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *xuésheng* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Grammar Lens: verb + 了 = finished

了 *le* — toneless, and placed **straight after the verb**. It says the action is **complete**.

我看书 — I read. / I'm reading. 我看了书 *wǒ kàn le shū* — I read it. I've read it. Done.

The verb did not move and did not change — the last chapter's rule holds. One small word went in behind it, and the event closed.

我有了名字 — I've got a name now. 你看了吗 *nǐ kàn le ma*

— have you read it?

That last one puts 了 and 吗 in the same sentence, each doing its own job at its own end: 了 sits behind the verb, 吗 at the very finish.

What you've built — the past this book could not reach

Until this line, **everything in this book happened in an eternal present.** Every sentence you could build was now, and there was no way to say a thing had already happened.
Spanish spends an imperfect, a preterite with two irregular sets, a present perfect and two participles on the same job. English has *read*, *have read*, *had read*, *was reading*. Mandarin has 了 and, when it needs one, a word for *yesterday*.
The verb still does not change. It never will. What changed is that a finished event can now be told apart from an unfinished one — and that is done by adding a particle, not by reshaping a word.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

了 is inherited from Middle Chinese *lewX*, "to finish" (Guangyun). As a verb it is still read *liǎo*, and the toneless particle is usually said to have grown out of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我看书 — 我看了书
- *wǒ yǒu le míngzi* — 我有了名字
- 你看了吗

Before you move on

Where does 了 go? (**Straight after the verb**.) What does it say? (**The action is finished**.) What happened to the verb when you added it? (**Nothing** — verbs never change.)

25.3 我是大学生了 — something has changed

One lesson back, and the same character in a different slot.

- *Recall:* say *le* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *gè* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *èrshí* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *bǎi* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zhōngwén* — *zhōngguó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *xué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Grammar Lens: 了 at the end says the situation is new

Put 了 at the very **end** of a sentence, after everything else, and it stops talking about the verb and starts talking about the situation:

> 我是大学生了 *wǒ shì dàxuéshēng le* — I'm a university student **now**. 有人了 — somebody's here **now**. 我看书了 — I'm reading now. *(I wasn't before)*

This 了 hangs off a whole finished sentence, not off any one word in it. That is why it goes last and why nothing may follow it.
The English word that keeps appearing in those translations is *now*, and it is not a translation of 了. It is what English has to reach for to carry what 了 does: *this was not so before, and it is so now.* Nothing in the Mandarin says *now.*

> 我是大学生 — I am a university student. *(a fact)* 我是大学生了 — I've become one. *(a change)*

Two slots, two jobs, one character. Behind the verb, 了 closes an action. At the end of the sentence, it opens a new state. This is what a language does when it refuses to inflect: it moves a small word around instead of reshaping a big one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我是大学生 — 我是大学生了
- 有人了
- 我看了书 — 我看书了

Before you move on

Where does this 了 go? (**At the very end of the sentence**.) What does it say? (**Something has changed**.) Is it the same character as the last lesson's? (**Yes** — same two strokes, different slot, different job.)

25.4 了 — aspect, and why it is not a tense

The chapter's fourth lesson, and it names what the other three were doing.

- *Recall:* say *wǒ shì dàxuéshēng le* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *gè* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *yìbǎi* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *wǔ* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì* — *hànzì* — *hànyǔ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *xué* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Grammar Lens: Mandarin marks completion, not time

了 is not a past tense. It marks **aspect** — whether an event is complete — and says nothing at all about when it happened.

Here is the proof, and it is the reason this lesson exists:

> 我看了书 — I read the book. *(finished — could be an hour ago)* 我看了书你看吗 — I've finished the book; are you going to read it?

The second sentence is not in the past. 了 says the reading is **over**, and whether that was this morning or will be by tonight is settled by a time word, not by the verb and not by 了.
So Mandarin splits the job English and Spanish fuse.

when it happened	a time word — *yesterday*, *now*, *tomorrow*
whether it is finished	a particle — 了

An English verb carries both at once: *read* against *reads* against *have read*. A Spanish verb carries both and the person as well. Mandarin carries neither in the verb, because the verb does not change — the last chapter's rule, arriving where it matters most.
This is the single largest shape difference between Mandarin and the languages this book's reader is likeliest to arrive from, and 了 is where a beginner first meets it. 了 is one of several aspect particles; the others come later.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我看了书
- 我看了书你看吗
- aspect is *whether it is finished*; tense is *when*

Before you move on

Is 了 a past tense? (**No** — it is aspect.) What does it actually mark? (**Whether the event is finished**.) What settles when something happened? (**A time word**, not the verb.)

25.5 我看了书

The chapter closes on two strokes.

- *Recall:* say *le* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǒ yǒu yí ge míngzi* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shíyī èrshí jiǔshíjiǔ yìbǎi* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎo bu hǎo* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì* — *hànzì* — *hànyǔ* — *zhōngwén* — *zhōngguó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *dàjiā* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

What you've built — two strokes, and time itself

Before this chapter every sentence in this book happened now. After it:

1. 我看了书 — a finished action. 了 behind the verb.
2. 我是大学生了 — a changed state. 了 at the end.
3. **Neither is a tense.** Mandarin marks whether, not when.

Two strokes did that. Compare the price: the verb chapter needed a character each for 看 and 书, and neither of them changed what could be *said about time*.
Listen. *Wǒ kàn le shū. Wǒ shì dàxuéshēng le. Nǐ kàn le ma?*
Speak. Say you have read the book; then say you have become a student.
Read it: 我看了书 — 有人了 — 你看了吗
Write it: 了 — the turn, then the hook

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我看了书
- *Say it:* 我是大学生了

- *Say it:* 你看了吗
- *Write it:* 了

Before you move on

Name the two slots 了 uses and what each does. (**After the verb, the action is finished; at the end, the situation has changed**.) Is either one a tense? (**No** — both are aspect.) How many strokes? (**Two**.)

Chapter 26

Ne and Dui

Modes: **voice** (2) **eyes** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

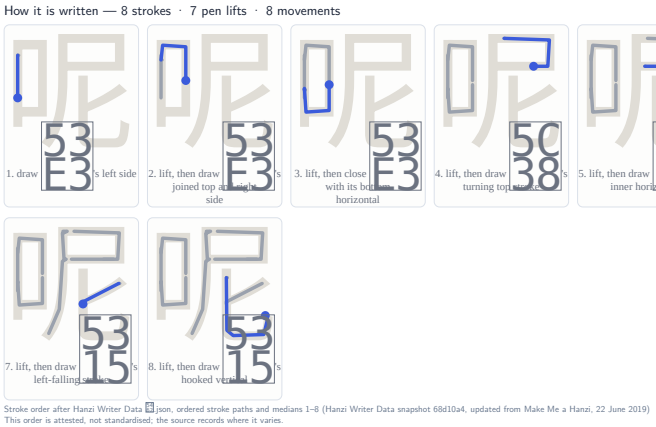
> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can hand a question back with 呢, agree with what somebody has said, and ask whether something is right.
>
> *Thirteen strokes make the first two-sided exchange in this book:* 吗 *could ask, and until now nothing could hand the question back or agree with the answer.*

26.1 呢 — 吗's shape, a different sound

A new chapter, and its first character is one you half know.

- *Recall:* say *wǒ kàn le shū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *le* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎo bu hǎo* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì* — *hànzì* — *hànyǔ* — *zhōngwén* — *zhōngguó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *dà* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — the same mouth, a different right half



How 呢 is written, stroke by stroke

呢

Eight strokes, and the first three are ones you have written since the fourth chapter.

1. 口's **shù** down the left side
2. 口's **héngzhé** across the top and down the right
3. 口's **héng** closing the floor

That is the same 口, in the same order, set small and high in the upper-left third of the square — **exactly where 吗 puts it.** Finish it before the right half starts.

Then 尼 *ní*, which supplies only the sound:

1. the **héngzhé** across the top of the right half and down at its right
2. the **héng** beneath it
3. the long **piě**, falling from the top all the way down to the lower left, past the bottom of 口
4. a short **piě** inside, falling left
5. the **shùwāngōu**, turning along the base and finishing to the right

Stroke 6 is the one that carries the character. It starts high and reaches the lower-left corner, and everything after it tucks inside.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 口 — then 呢, mouth first
- *Cover:* write 吗 and 呢 side by side and compare the left halves

Before you move on

Which three strokes open 呢? (**口's** — vertical, turn, floor.) Which other character starts the same way? (吗.) Which stroke is the long one? (**The sixth**, falling to the lower left.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 呢, pinned stroke paths and medians.

26.2 呢 — and you?

One lesson back, and the character is under your pen.

- *Recall:* say *ne* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *le* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *wǒ shì* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shì ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì* — *hànzì* — *hànyǔ* — *zhōngwén* — *zhōngguó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *dà* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Grammar Lens: put 呢 after a noun and it asks the last question again

呢 *ne* — toneless, placed after a noun or a pronoun. It repeats whatever question was on the table, about this one instead.

— 你是学生吗 — Are you a student? — 我是学生你呢 *nǐ ne* — I'm a student. **And you?**

你呢 is two syllables and a complete turn. Nothing has to be repeated:

呢 carries the whole of the previous question with it.

我是中国人你呢 我有一个名字你呢 我看了书你呢

Every one of those means something different, and 呢 is the same in all of them, because the question it asks is whichever one was already on the table.

What you've built — the second particle, and the pair

Keep 吗 and 呢 apart by what comes before them:

吗	after a **whole statement**	你是学生吗 — a yes-or-no question
呢	after a **noun**	你呢 — the last question, asked again

They cannot be swapped. 你吗 is not a question and 你是学生呢 is not the question you meant.

呢 is the second of Mandarin's particles this book has taught, and the third toneless word after 吗 and 的. **A Mandarin sentence's grammar lives in words like these** — small, unstressed, unchanging, and placed rather than inflected. That is what the reader is learning each time one arrives.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

呢 borrowed its character for the sound; where the particle itself comes from is not settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我是学生你呢
- 我是中国人你呢
- 你是学生吗 — 你呢 — hear the difference

Before you move on

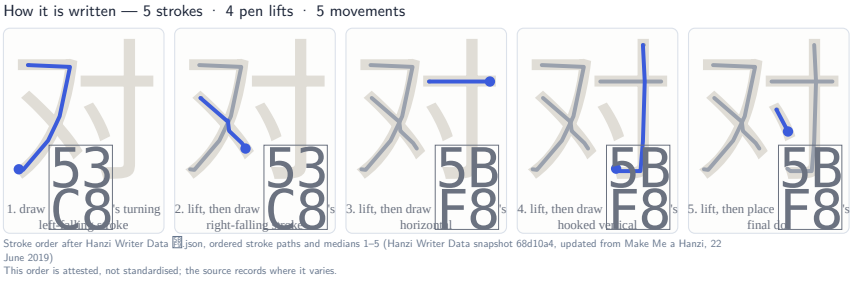
What does 呢 do? (**Asks the last question again, about somebody else.**) What comes before it? (**A noun** — 你呢.) And what comes before 吗? (**A whole statement.**)

26.3 对 — five strokes, and a hand on the left

Two lessons in, and this one is short.

- *Recall:* say *ne* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǒ shì dàxuéshēng le* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shū* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shì ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *zì* — *hànzì* — *hànyǔ* — *zhōngwén* — *zhōngguó* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *rén* — *nǚ* — *érzi* — *nǚ'ér* — *jiā* — *jiārén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — a hand, and a thumb's width



How 对 *is written, stroke by stroke*

对

Five strokes. Two on the left, three on the right.
The left half is 又, an old picture of a hand:

1. the **héngpiě** — a short flat start that turns and falls to the lower left, one stroke, no lift
2. the **nà**, crossing it and falling to the lower right

The right half is 寸:

1. the **héng** across the right half
2. the long **shùgōu** down through it, hooking left at the foot
3. the **diǎn** dot, placed last, to the left of the hook

The dot is the final stroke — the same rule 的 followed. And the left half is finished before the right begins, as always.

Hold on to strokes 1 and 2. That 又 opens 欢 two chapters from now, and you will not have to learn it twice.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 对 — 又's two, then 寸's three, dot last
- *Cover:* write it again from memory

Before you move on

How many strokes does 对 have? (**Five**.) Which stroke is the dot? (**The last**.) And which later character shares its left half? (欢.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 对, pinned stroke paths and medians.

26.4 对 — right, and the sound of agreeing

One lesson back, and this word does two jobs.

- *Recall:* say *duì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *le* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *Zhōngguó rén* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back

- *Recall:* say *nǐ hǎo ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *jiārén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

The sounds and tones in this word

对 *duì* is **fourth tone** — the sharp fall, the same shape as 四, 六 and 个.

> 对 — Right. Correct. 不对 *bú duì* — Wrong. Not right. 对不对 *duì bu duì* — Right or not?

That last one is a shape you already own. The asking chapter taught 好不好, the verb-not-verb question, and 对不对 is the same pattern on a new word — no new grammar at all, one new syllable.
And the 不 in front of 对 rises: *bú duì*, not *bù duì*. That is the 不 sandhi the 是 chapter taught on 不是, working exactly as it did there, because 对 is fourth tone too.

Why it's said this way

On its own, 对 is what a Mandarin speaker says while somebody else is talking to show they are following and they agree. English uses *right*, *yeah*, *mm*; Mandarin uses 对, often doubled — 对对
Until this line, this book had no backchannel at all. You could greet, ask, count and name, and while somebody spoke to you there was nothing to say. That is not a small gap: a listener who makes no sound at all reads, in Mandarin as in English, as a listener who has not understood.

> — 你是中国人吗 — 对

Two syllables, and a whole exchange finished.
Careful with one thing. 对 agrees with a **statement**. It is not a general *yes*: asked a question with a verb in it, a Mandarin speaker answers by repeating the verb — 是 for a 是 question, 有 for a 有 question. 对 is for agreeing that what was said is so.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

对 is inherited from Middle Chinese *twojH*, glossed "to answer; to match" (Guangyun); "correct" is the later sense.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 对 不对 对不对
- 你是中国人吗 — 对
- 对对

Before you move on

What does 对 mean? (**Right, correct**.) What does it do on its own in a conversation? (**Shows you are following and agree**.) And how is 不对 said? (***Bú duì*** — 不 rises before a fourth tone.)

26.5 你呢 — 对不对

The chapter closes with an exchange rather than a word.

- *Recall:* say *duì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǒ kàn le shū* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *Zhōngguó rén* — *shū* — *kàn* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *nǐ hǎo ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *yán* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

What you've built — a turn each way

Two characters, thirteen strokes, and here is what they buy — a conversation that goes both ways:

— 你是学生吗 — 对你呢 — 我是大学生了 — 对对

Every line of that is short, and none of it was sayable before this chapter. 吗 could ask; nothing could hand the question back, and nothing could agree.
呢 after a noun asks the last question again. 对 agrees with a statement. 吗 after a whole statement asks a yes-or-no question. Three particles, three slots, and not one of them changes shape.
Listen. *Nǐ shì xuésheng ma? — Duì. Nǐ ne?*
Speak. Answer, then hand it back with 你呢.
Read it: 你是学生吗 — 对 — 你呢
Write it: 呢 — 口 first; 对 — 又 first, dot last

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你是学生吗 — 对你呢
- *Say it:* 对不对 — 对
- *Write it:* 呢 对

Before you move on

Which particle hands the question back? (呢, after a noun.) Which word agrees with a statement? (对.) And which one turns a statement into a question? (吗, at the end.)

Chapter 27

Age, and And

Modes: **voice** (1) **eyes** (2) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

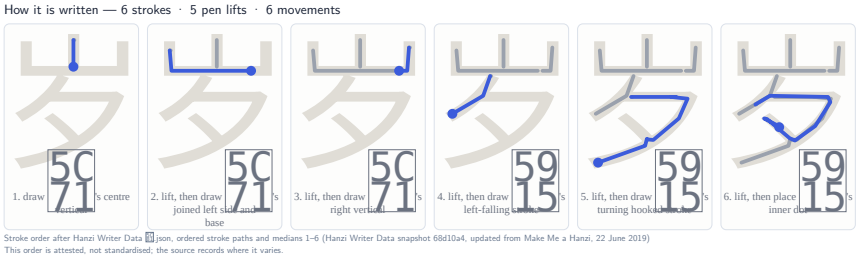
> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how old I am in a sentence with no verb in it, and join two nouns with 和 while knowing it may not join two sentences.
>
> *岁 gives the numerals their first thing to measure, and 和 is the first joining word this track has ever had — one that teaches where it may not go.*

27.1 岁 — six strokes, and a rule that is not left-to-right

A new chapter, and its first character breaks a habit.

- *Recall:* say *nǐ ne — duì bu duì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *ne* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *de* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *shénme* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — a mountain, then an evening



How 岁 is written, stroke by stroke

岁

Six strokes, three on top and three beneath.

The top is 山 *shān*, a mountain — and it is written in an order the rules you have been given do not predict:

1. the **shù** down the **middle**
2. the **shùzhé** — down the left side, then turn and run along the base
3. the **shù** down the right side

Centre before the sides. Every character so far has gone top before bottom and left before right, and those two rules decide almost everything in Chinese writing. 山 is where they run out, and the answer is a third rule: when a shape has a clear middle and two wings, the middle goes first.

The bottom is 夕 *xī*, an evening:

1. a short **piě** falling to the lower left
2. the **héngzhégōu**, turning down and falling to the lower left with a hook
3. the **diǎn** dot laid across it

Top before bottom holds between the halves, as always.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 山 — middle first, then left, then right
- *Write it:* 岁 — 山 on top, 夕 beneath
- *Cover:* write 岁 from memory

Before you move on

How many strokes does 岁 have? (**Six**.) Which stroke of 山 comes first? (**The middle one**.) What sits underneath? (夕, an evening.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 岁, pinned stroke paths and medians.

27.2 岁 — how old you are

One lesson back, and the numerals finally do something.

- *Recall:* say *suì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *ne* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *de* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ma* — **R3**, durable again, a second word from that distance
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *shénme* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

The sounds and tones in this word

岁 *suì* is **fourth tone** — the sharp fall, like 四 and 对.
It counts **years of age**, and only that. It is not the word for a year on a calendar.

十八岁 *shíbā suì* — eighteen years old 二十岁 — twenty 九十九岁 — ninety-nine

Every one of those numbers came from the decimal chapter, and until this word there was nothing for them to measure.

Grammar Lens: the sentence with no verb in it

我十八岁 *wǒ shíbā suì* — I am eighteen.

Say that again and listen for the verb. **There is none.** No 是, no anything. Subject, number, 岁, stop.
English needs *am*. Spanish needs *tengo*. Mandarin puts an age straight after the person and is finished — and putting 是 in is a mistake a beginner makes for months: 我是十八岁 is wrong.
The question is built the same way, with 吗 doing what it always does:

你十八岁吗 — are you eighteen?

And now three things this book taught separately can be said in one breath:

我是中国人 — 我有一个名字 — 我十八岁

Name, nationality, age — the three pieces of personal information any beginner's paper asks for, and the last of them was waiting on this one character.
One habit worth knowing. Mandarin asks a small child's age with one question and an adult's with another, and both need words this book has not taught yet. What this lesson gives you is the answer, which is the half you are asked for.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

岁 is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjwejH*, "year" (Guangyun); Unihan also gives "age".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *shíbā suì* — 十八岁
- 我十八岁 — and hear that there is no verb
- 你十八岁吗

Before you move on

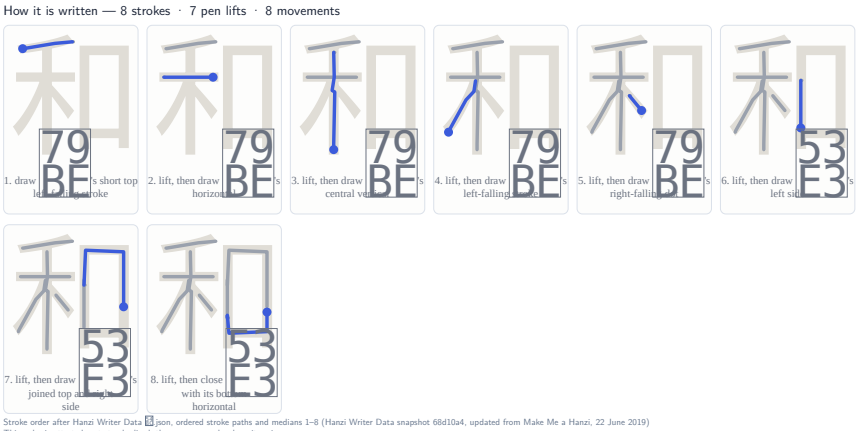
What does 岁 count? (**Years of age**.) What verb does 我十八岁 use? (**None** — there is no verb in it.) What is the commonest beginner's mistake here? (**Putting 是 in**.)

27.3 和 — eight strokes, and the right half is a mouth

Two lessons in, and three of these eight strokes are already yours.

- *Recall:* say *suì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *duì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kàn shū de rén* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *me* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — 禾 first, then 口



How 和 is written, stroke by stroke

和

Eight strokes, five on the left and three on the right — and the three on the right are 口, which you have written since the fourth chapter.

The left half is 禾 *hé*, standing grain:

1. a short **piě** at the very top, falling left
2. the **héng** beneath it
3. the long **shù** straight down the middle
4. a **piě** falling to the lower left
5. a **diǎn** closing to the lower right

Then 口, in its usual order:

1. the **shù** down its left side
2. the **héngzhé** across the top and down the right
3. the **héng** closing the floor

Left half complete before the right one starts, as always.

This is a **phono-semantic compound**, the kind the 请 lesson named: one part carries meaning and the other carries sound. Here the sounding half is unusually generous — 禾 is itself said *hé*, so the character tells you its own pronunciation outright.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 禾 — then 和, with 口 on the right
- *Cover:* write 和 from memory

Before you move on

How many strokes does 和 have? (**Eight** — five plus 口's three.) Which half supplies the sound? (禾, which is itself *hé*.) Which earlier character worked the same way? (请.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 和, pinned stroke paths and medians.

27.4 和 — and, between things only

One lesson back, and this word opens a column this book has never had.

- *Recall:* say *hé* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *duì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *Hànyǔ, wǒ kàn shū* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kànjiàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *shén* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

The sounds and tones in this word

和 *hé* is **second tone** — the rise, the same shape as 十 and 人.

> 你和我 *nǐ hé wǒ* — you and I 书和名字 — books and names 中国人和学生

It stands between the two things and joins them. Nothing agrees, nothing changes, and it is the same word however many things there are.

Grammar Lens: it joins nouns, and only nouns

> **和 joins two nouns. It does NOT join two sentences.**

This is the part an English or Spanish speaker gets wrong on the first day, because in their language one word does both:

> **Right:** 我和你 — you and I *(two nouns)* **Wrong:** 我看书和你看书 — not Mandarin at all

English says *I read and you read.* Spanish says *yo leo y tú lees.* Mandarin will not use 和 there at all. To join two statements it **puts them next to each other**, with a comma and no joining word:

> 我看书 — 你看书 — I read, and you read.

Mandarin writes a comma at that seam; this book prints a dash, because it has taught no punctuation. What matters is that **there is no joining word in it at all.** That is not a shortcut or a casual register — it is how Mandarin does it, and the words that DO join clauses are different words for different relations, *because*, *but*, *or*, none of which is 和 and none of which this book has yet taught.
So 和 is the first joining word in this track, and the first thing it teaches is where it may not go.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

和 is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwa*, "in harmony" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); its use as "and" is a later development, usually traced through "together with".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nǐ hé wǒ* — 你和我
- 书和名字
- 我看书 — 你看书 — two sentences, no 和

Before you move on

What does 和 join? (**Two nouns**.) What does it never join? (**Two sentences**.) How does Mandarin join two statements instead? (**It puts them side by side**, with a comma.)

27.5 我十八岁 — 你和我

The chapter closes on two unrelated characters that each open a column.

- *Recall:* say *hé* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *nǐ ne — duì bu duì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back

- *Recall:* say *wǒ de shū — kàn shū de rén* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kànjiàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *wǒ shì* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

What you've built — an age, and a join

Two characters, fourteen strokes, and each one opens something the track has never had.
岁 gives the numerals something to measure. The decimal chapter reached ninety-nine and had nothing to count; 我十八岁 is the first sentence in this book that uses a number to say something true about a person — and it does it with no verb at all.
和 is the first joining word in the whole track. It joins two nouns and it refuses two sentences, and knowing the refusal is most of the lesson. Put them together with what you already have:

我是中国人 — 我有一个名字 — 我十八岁 你和我是学生

Listen. *Wǒ shíbā suì. Nǐ hé wǒ shì xuésheng.*
Speak. Give your age with no verb; then join two people with 和.
Read. 我十八岁 — 你和我是学生
Write. 岁 — 山 middle-first, then 夕. 和 — 禾, then 口.

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我十八岁
- *Say it:* 你和我是学生
- *Write it:* 岁 和

Before you move on

What verb does an age sentence use? (**None**.) What does 和 join, and what does it refuse? (**Nouns; sentences**.) Which stroke of 山 comes first? (**The middle one**.)

Chapter 28

Xihuan — What You Like

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

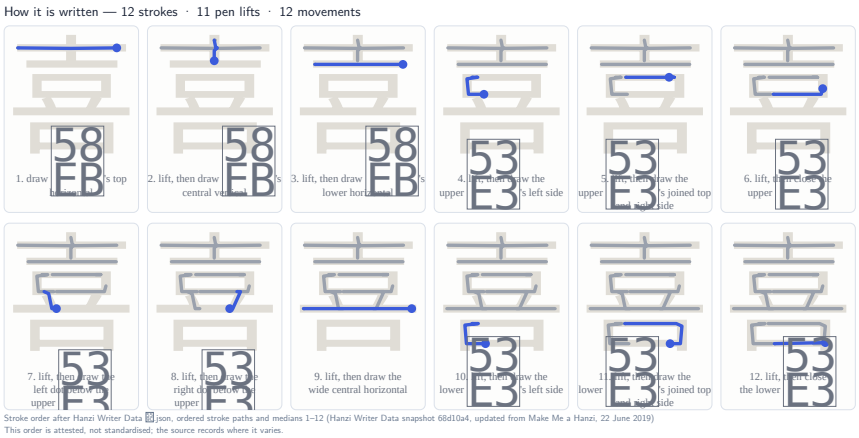
> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I like and do not like, and ask somebody else what they like.
>
> *Eighteen strokes and one verb, and the liking frame every other language in this series makes a beginner turn round: in Mandarin the liker is simply the subject.*

28.1 喜 — twelve strokes, stacked in four bands

A new chapter, and its first character is the tallest in the book.

- *Recall:* say *wǒ shíbā suì — nǐ hé wǒ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *suì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎokàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *míngzi* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — read it downwards, in four bands



How 喜 *is written, stroke by stroke*

喜

Twelve strokes — more than any character you have written. Do not count them. **Read the character downwards in four bands**, and every band is a shape you already know.

Band one — 士, three strokes. A long **héng** across the top, a **shù** down through it, a shorter **héng** beneath. That is 十 with a longer bar on top.

Band two — 口, three strokes. Left side, joined top-and-right, closing floor. The same mouth as always.

Band three — two short strokes, a small pair leaning apart under the 口.

Band four — one long héng, then 口 again. Stroke 9 is the widest stroke in the character, running edge to edge, and it carries everything above it. Then the lower 口, in its usual three.

3 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 3 = twelve.

Top before bottom, all the way down. Two 口, and both of them are written the way you have written 口 since 吗.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 士 — 口 — the small pair — the long bar — 口

- *Write it:* 喜, all twelve, downwards
- *Cover:* write it again and count the bands, not the strokes

Before you move on

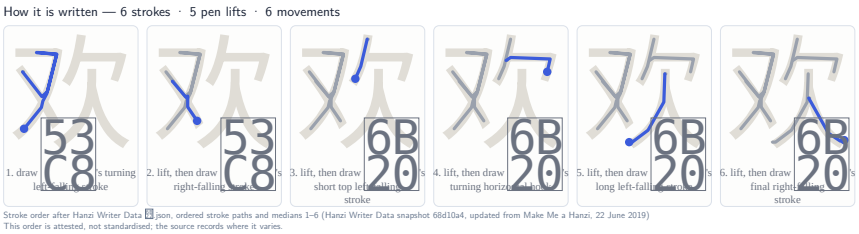
How many strokes does 喜 have? (**Twelve**.) How many bands? (**Four**.) How many of them are 口? (**Two** — the middle band and the last.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 喜, pinned stroke paths and medians.

28.2 欢 — six strokes, and two of them are already yours

One lesson back, and this one is short by comparison.

- *Recall:* say *xǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *suì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎokàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *zì* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

Script — 又 again, then 欠



How 欢 *is written, stroke by stroke*

欢

Six strokes, and the first two are ones you wrote one chapter ago. The left half is 又, the hand:

1. the **héngpiě** — a short flat start that turns and falls to the lower left
2. the **nà**, crossing it and falling to the lower right

That is exactly how 对 begins. Same pair, same order, same place in the square.

The right half is 欠 *qiàn*, a person with an open mouth:

1. a short **piě** at the top, falling left
2. the **hénggōu** — a horizontal that hooks down at its end
3. the long **piě**, falling from under the hook to the lower left
4. the **nà**, falling to the lower right and reaching furthest of all

Strokes 5 and 6 are the character's legs, and they must both reach out. Cramped, 欢 looks like something else; spread, it is unmistakable.

After 喜's twelve, six will feel like nothing.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 又 — the two strokes that also open 对
- *Write it:* 欢, all six
- *Cover:* write 对 and 欢 side by side and check the left halves match

Before you move on

How many strokes does 欢 have? (**Six**.) Which character shares its left half? (对.) Which two strokes are the legs? (**The fifth and sixth** — both must reach out.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 欢, pinned stroke paths and medians.

28.3 喜欢 — what you like

Two characters in, and now they say something.

- *Recall:* say *huān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *hé* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *gè* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kàn* — *kànjiàn* — *hǎokàn* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *míng* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

The sounds and tones in this word

喜欢 is *xǐhuan* — **third tone, then nothing.**
喜 is third tone, the dip. 欢 is first tone on its own — but inside this word it **loses its tone altogether** and goes light: *xǐ-huan*, not *xǐ-huān*. That is the same thing 早上 does to 上, and 名字 to 字.
Say it once slowly and once at speed: **xǐ huan**.

Grammar Lens: the liker is the subject, and that is all

person + 喜欢 + the thing liked.

我喜欢看书 *wǒ xǐhuan kàn shū* — I like reading. 我喜欢中国 — I like China. 你喜欢汉语吗 — do you like Chinese?

That is an ordinary sentence with an ordinary verb and an ordinary object, and saying so is the point. Spanish and Italian make a beginner turn the sentence round: Spanish says *me gusta el libro* — "the book pleases me" — and Italian says *mi piace*, with the liker in an object slot and the thing liked as the subject. Learners spend weeks on it. **Mandarin asks nothing of you here.** The person who likes goes in front, the verb does not change, and the thing liked follows. It is the same shape as 我看书.
And 不 works on it normally, which 有 did not:

我不喜欢看书 — I don't like reading.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

喜欢 is a Chinese compound of two words for joy, both inherited from Middle Chinese: *xiX*, "glad", and *xwan*, "joy" (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *xǐhuan* — 喜欢, and let 欢 go light
- 我喜欢看书
- 我不喜欢看书

Before you move on

What tones does 喜欢 carry? (**Third, then none** — 欢 goes light.)
Who goes in front of it? (**The person who likes** — no inversion.)
Does 不 negate it normally? (**Yes** — 我不喜欢.)

28.4 你喜欢什么 — what do you like?

Four in, and this lesson joins two chapters that never met.

- *Recall:* say *xǐhuan* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *hé* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *gè* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shū* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *wǒ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

You'll want to know: the question, and where 什么 sits

你喜欢什么 *nǐ xǐhuan shénme* — **what do you like?**

Four words, and all of them were already in the book except 喜欢.

Now notice where 什么 is. It is at the END, in exactly the slot the answer would occupy:

— 你喜欢什么 — what do you like? — 我喜欢书 — I like books.

Mandarin does not move a question word. English hauls *what* to the front and reshuffles everything behind it — *you like what* becomes *what do you like*, with a *do* invented on the way. Mandarin leaves 什么 exactly where the answer goes and changes nothing else. Question and answer have the same shape, word for word.

That is why no 吗 is needed here. 吗 makes a yes-or-no question; a sentence that already contains 什么 is a question, and adding 吗 would be wrong.

你喜欢汉语吗 — do you like Chinese? *(yes or no)* 你喜欢什么 — what do you like? *(name it)*

And the whole exchange, with the particle from the last chapter:

— 你喜欢什么 — 我喜欢看书你呢

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Chinese built the question from words it already had: *nǐ*, *xǐhuan*, from Middle Chinese *xiX* and *xwan*, and *shénme*, whose origin is not settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 你喜欢什么
- 我喜欢看书你呢
- 你喜欢汉语吗 — and hear why this one needs 吗

Before you move on

Where does 什么 stand? (**Where the answer goes** — at the end.) Does Mandarin move it to the front? (**No** — nothing moves.) Why is there no 吗? (**A sentence with 什么 in it is already a**

question.)

28.5 我喜欢看书

The last chapter of the tranche closes here.

- *Recall:* say *nǐ xǐhuan shénme* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǒ shíbā suì — nǐ hé wǒ* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *wǒ yǒu yí ge míngzi* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *shū* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *wǒ* — **R4**, recognition at distance, a second word from that far back

What you've built — liking, said plainly

Two characters, eighteen strokes, one verb — and with it a whole area of talk this book could not enter:

> 我喜欢看书 — I like reading. 我不喜欢看书 — I don't. 你喜欢什么 — what do you like? 你喜欢汉语吗 — do you like Chinese?

Nothing there is inverted, nothing agrees, nothing moves. The liker is the subject; the thing liked is the object; 什么 stands where the answer stands. Spanish and Italian both make you turn that round; Mandarin does not.
And now the whole tranche can be said in one breath, because every piece of it is yours:

> 我是中国人 — 我十八岁 — 我有一个名字 — 我喜欢看书 — 你呢

Listen. *Wǒ xǐhuan kàn shū. Nǐ xǐhuan shénme?*
Speak. Say what you like; ask what the other person likes; hand it back with 你呢.

Read it: 我喜欢看书 — 你喜欢什么
Write it: 喜 — four bands, twelve strokes; 欢 — 又, then 欠

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我喜欢看书 我不喜欢看书
- *Say it:* 你喜欢什么 — 我喜欢书你呢
- *Write it:* 喜 欢

Before you move on

Say "I like reading." (我喜欢看书.) Where does 什么 go in the question? (**At the end, where the answer goes**.) And what does Mandarin ask you to turn round here? (**Nothing at all**.)

Chapter 29

Reading — Characters, Words, and a First Passage

Modes: **eyes** (3) **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read a Chinese character cold, find where a word ends when nothing marks it, and hold a whole passage without translating it character by character.
>
> *Thirty-four characters in a row with no new character in them, including the first line in the book whose meaning depends on the lines before it.*

29.1 (reading) — six characters, nothing said first

You have written every one of these. Not one is new.

What is new is that nobody is going to say them first.

Read this

人 书 看 有 和 十

Read down the list once. Do not count strokes — look at the whole character and let it arrive.
Again, and notice which came at once and which you had to take apart. Both are fine. The difference is what practice removes.

What to know first

In an alphabet a single letter is almost never a word. Here every one of these six is.

That changes what reading is. There is no sounding out: a character either lands whole or it does not land, and the only thing that moves it from the second to the first is having met it before.

Six is enough for one sitting, because six is already six words.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six characters down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
How many of them are whole words? (**All six.**)

29.2 (reading) — six words, not six characters

The last lesson gave you six characters that were each a word. These are six words that are not each a character.

Every character in them is still one you have written.

Read this

中国人 我的书 看书的人 一个 十八岁 喜欢

Read it: the six words down once, without stopping
Read it: the six words again, and this time notice there is nothing between the characters
No space tells you where one word ends.

What to know first

看书的人 is four characters and one idea: the person who reads. You know all four, and knowing them is not the same as seeing where the join falls.

That is the work this lesson does. Mandarin writes no spaces, so a reader has to decide where a word ends, and the only tool for it is having met the word before.

喜欢 is the clearest case: two characters that mean nothing apart, and *to like* together.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many characters are in 看书的人? (**Four.**) How many words? (**One.**)
What tells you where a word ends? (**Nothing on the page** — only having met it.)

29.3 (reading) — the first passage

Six characters, then six words. Now ten lines.

Thirty-four characters, and not one of them is new.

Read this

我是中国人 我有一个名字 我看书 我喜欢看书 我十八岁 你呢 对不对 你好 谢谢 再见

Read it: the passage through once without stopping; do not translate as you go
Read it: the passage again, and this time notice that the passage turns at line six
The first five are about the writer. The last five are addressed to you.

What to know first

你呢 is two characters and does the work of a whole English sentence: *and what about you?* It only means that because of the five lines before it, which is the first time this book has asked a line to depend on what came earlier.

我十八岁 has no verb in it at all. Mandarin states an age by putting the number and 岁 straight after the person, and a reader who waits for a verb waits forever.

This is the first whole passage the book has asked you to hold at once, and it works because every character was paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the passage aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Which line depends on the five before it? (你呢)
Which line has no verb? (我十八岁 — and it needs none.)

Chapter 30

How Are You?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how somebody is and answer that I am fine, busy, tired or so-so.
>
> *The everyday way to ask how somebody is, and four answers to it, built on one new written character: 很, the plain link Mandarin puts in front of an adjective.*

30.1 zěnmeyàng — how are you doing?

A new chapter, and it opens with a question you can ask anybody you know.

- *Recall:* say *nǐ ne* — **R1**, the line that turned the passage one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *nǐ xǐhuan shénme* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *wǒ yǒu yí ge míngzi* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *zǎoshang hǎo* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more

The sounds and tones in this word

zěnmeyàng — **a dip, a light syllable, then a fall.**
zěn is third tone. *me* is the same toneless syllable that ends 什么. *yàng*

is fourth tone, and it carries the weight of the word.

nǐ zěnmeyàng — How are you doing?

Say it once slowly and once at speed: **zěn me yàng**.

Why it's said this way

You already have 你好吗 *nǐ hǎo ma*, and it is correct. It is the question textbooks open with.
Between people who know each other, the one you will hear far more often is *nǐ zěnmeyàng*: "how are things with you?" On its own, *zěnmeyàng* asks how something is, and putting 你 in front makes the something you.
So keep both. 你好吗 is the careful one; *nǐ zěnmeyàng* is the one a friend asks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Mandarin builds *zěnmeyàng* from three syllables. *me* is the light 么 from 什么, a character you know. The characters for *zěn* and *yàng* come later; this chapter keeps them to the ear.
No dictionary we use records an older form of *zěn* or *yàng*, so the history of the word is not settled, and where 么 comes from is not settled either.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *zěnmeyàng* — dip, light, fall
- *nǐ zěnmeyàng*
- 你好吗, then the everyday one, *nǐ zěnmeyàng*

Before you move on

What tones does *zěnmeyàng* carry? (**Third, none, fourth.**) Which question would a friend ask you? (***nǐ zěnmeyàng*** — 你好吗 is the one textbooks open with.)

30.2 很 — the word in front of an adjective

The question is in place. This lesson gives you the word every answer needs.

- *Recall:* say *nǐ zěnmeyàng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *xǐhuan* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *wǒ de shū* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *hǎo* — **R4**, recognition at distance, the first word in this book

The sounds and tones in this word

很 is *hěn* — **third tone**, the dip, the same as 好.
Its pieces, in words: on the left, the person piece from 你 with one more left-falling stroke above it; on the right, a piece read *gěn*. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Grammar Lens: no 是, and a plain 很 instead

我很好 *wǒ hěn hǎo* — I'm fine.

In Mandarin an adjective is the whole predicate: there is no 是 in "I am fine", and a plain 很 stands in front of 好 instead. Here 很 has lost most of its *very*, so 我很好 is "I'm fine", while a bare 我好 sounds like the start of a contrast — I am fine, but somebody else is not.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

很 is an old character: the Guangyun records it as *honX* (in Baxter's transcription), glossed "defiant". How that word came to mean "very" is not settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hěn* — dip it

- 我很好
- *nǐ zěnmeyàng* — 我很好

Before you move on

Does 是 go in front of an adjective? (**No — a plain 很 does.**)
What does 我很好 mean? (**I'm fine** — 很 has lost most of its *very*.)

30.3 很 — nine strokes, two pieces

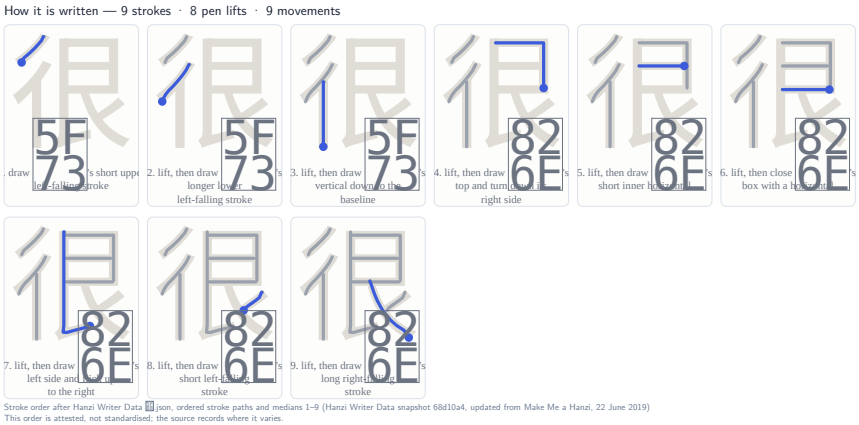
Three characters first, read cold, before the new piece arrives.

- *Recall:* say *hěn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *shíbā suì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back

人 亻 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, the person piece, *nǐ*

Script — two pieces, left before right



How 很 *is written, stroke by stroke*

很

Nine strokes, but two pieces. Do not count to nine. Read the character across, left piece first, the way you write 你.

The left piece, 彳, three strokes. Its lower two are the person piece 亻 you have written since 你: a left-falling stroke, then a vertical down to the foot. 彳 adds one more short left-falling stroke above them. So: a short fall, a longer fall, then the vertical.

The right piece, 艮, six strokes. A horizontal that turns down the right side of a box without lifting. A short horizontal inside it. A horizontal that closes the box. Then the left side, down to the foot, flicking up to the right. A short left-falling stroke on the right, and last the long right-falling stroke.

3 + 6 = nine, and the first three are a shape your hand already knows.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 亻, then 彳 — the same two strokes with one more fall above them
- *Write it:* 很, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 很 have? (**Nine**.) How many pieces? (**Two** — 彳, then 艮.) Which piece is the person piece with one stroke added? (**彳, on the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 很, pinned stroke paths and medians.

30.4 很好 — I'm fine

Nine strokes in your hand. Now they become an answer.

- *Recall:* say *hěn* — **R1**, the character one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *duì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back

- *Recall:* say *nǐ hǎo* — **R4**, recognition at distance, the first word in this book

The sounds and tones in this word

很好 is *hěn hǎo* — **two third tones side by side.**
You met this in the first chapter with 你好, and the same rule fires again: the first of the two rises. Spoken, it is *hén hǎo*. Written, it stays *hěn hǎo*, and the characters do not change at all.
Say it slowly once, then at speed, and let 很 rise into 好.

Why it's said this way

我很好 *wǒ hěn hǎo* — I'm fine.

That is the answer to *nǐ zěnmeyàng* and to 你好吗. It means "I'm fine", not "I'm very well": 很 is there because 好 is an adjective and wants it in front. Put weight on 很, and the *very* comes back.

Read this

我很好你呢

Five characters, and nothing on the page marks where one word stops. Find the words before reading on.
我 — 很好 — 你 — 呢. Four words; 很好 is the only one with two characters.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

很好 is built from 很 and 好. 好 is inherited from Middle Chinese *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); 很 is the character the Guangyun records as *honX*, "defiant", and how it came to mean "very" is not settled.

Your turn

- *Say it: hén hǎo* — let the first one rise
- *Say it: nǐ zěnmeyàng* — 我很好
- *Write it:* 很好

Before you move on

Which of the two syllables in 很好 rises when you say it? (**The first, 很.**)

30.5 máng — busy

One answer so far. This lesson adds a second, and it is not "fine".

- *Recall:* say *wǒ hěn hǎo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *nǐ zěnmeyàng* — **R2**, the question that opened this chapter
- *Recall:* say *yǒu* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *zǎoshang* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more

The sounds and tones in this word

máng — **second tone**, rising, like a surprised "huh?". Its character comes later; this chapter keeps it to the ear.

Grammar Lens: the same shape as 我很好

máng is an adjective, so it works exactly like 好: no 是, a plain 很 in front.

> *wǒ hěn máng* — I'm busy. *zǎoshang wǒ hěn máng* — I'm busy in the mornings.

zǎoshang goes first, before the person: the time is what the sentence is about, then comes what happens in it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

máng is probably inherited from Middle Chinese *mang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where it is glossed "afraid". Flustered becoming busy is a likely path for the sense, but it is not settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *máng* — let it rise
- *wǒ hěn máng*
- *zǎoshang wǒ hěn máng*

Before you move on

What tone is *máng*? (**Second, rising.**) What goes in front of it? (**A plain 很**, as in front of 好.) Where does *zǎoshang* go? (**First, before the person.**)

30.6 lèi — tired

Busy all morning, and now you are tired. You step into a lift, and the panel reads:

九

Say it: jiǔ — the ninth floor, read off the wall, the way you first read floor numbers

- *Recall:* say *máng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *xǐhuan* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *yí ge* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back

The sounds and tones in this word

lèi — **fourth tone**, a short clean fall. Its character comes later; this chapter keeps it to the ear.

Grammar Lens: a statement, then 吗

lèi is an adjective too. Ask with 吗 on the end, and answer with 很:

nǐ lèi ma — Are you tired? *wǒ hěn lèi* — I'm tired.

The question is the statement with 吗 added; nothing moves.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

The character for *lèi* is in the Guangyun, read *ljweX* and *ljweH* (Baxter's transcription), but glossed "accumulate" and "implicate". "Tired" is not among its senses there, so how the word came to mean it is not settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *lèi* — fall
- *nǐ lèi ma*
- *wǒ hěn lèi*

Before you move on

What tone is *lèi*? (**Fourth, falling.**) How do you ask "are you tired?" (***nǐ lèi ma*** — the statement, then 吗.) And the lift panel? (九, ***jiǔ.***)

30.7 hái xíng — not bad

Fine, busy, tired. Most days are none of those, and this lesson is for them.

- *Recall:* say *lèi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *duì* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *nǐ hé wǒ* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *bù* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more

Read this

早上好 你好吗 我很好 你呢

Read it: the three lines aloud as one exchange, without stopping between them
The last line hands the question back. This lesson gives you a third way to answer it.

The sounds and tones in this word

hái xíng — **two rising tones.**
hái is "still"; *xíng* is "OK, it works". Together: "still OK" — not bad. Its characters come later; this chapter keeps the word to the ear.

hái xíng, nǐ ne — Not bad. And you?

Why it's said this way

很好 says things are good. *hái xíng* says they are all right, and it is the answer people give when they are not going to complain. Said with a shrug, it can mean "could be better".

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hái xíng is built from *hái* "still" and *xíng* "all right". Both characters are in the Guangyun (Baxter's transcription): the one for *hái* as *hwaen*, "return", and the one for *xíng* as *haeng*, "walk, go". How they came to mean "still" and "all right" is not settled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hái xíng* — rise, rise
- *hái xíng, nǐ ne*

Before you move on

What tones does *hái xíng* carry? (**Two rising tones.**) Which answer is between *hěn hǎo* and *hěn lèi*? (***hái xíng*** — not bad.)

30.8 nǐ zěnmeyàng — wǒ hěn hǎo

The chapter closes here, with a whole exchange.

- *Recall:* say *hái xíng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *wǒ xǐhuan kàn shū* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *wǒ shì zhōngguórén* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *zǎoshang hǎo* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more

The exchange

A: 早上好

zǎoshang hǎo — good morning.

B: 早上好 — *nǐ zěnmeyàng*

zǎoshang hǎo, nǐ zěnmeyàng — good morning. How are you doing?

A: 我很好 你呢

wǒ hěn hǎo, nǐ ne — I'm fine. And you?

B: *hái xíng, wǒ hěn máng* — not bad. I'm busy.

A: *nǐ lèi ma* — are you tired?

B: *hěn lèi, zàijiàn* — I am. Goodbye.

A: 再见

zàijiàn — goodbye.

The words whose characters this book has not written yet stay in pinyin; you know them by ear, and here the ear carries them. The morning greeting is one of the first things this book gave you, and this is the first exchange to carry on past it.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — four answers to one question

One question, *nǐ zěnmeyàng*, and four answers, every one of them with a plain 很 or none at all:

- *wǒ hěn hǎo* — I'm fine.
- *hái xíng* — not bad.
- *wǒ hěn máng* — I'm busy.
- *wǒ hěn lèi* — I'm tired.

Listen. *Nǐ zěnmeyàng?*
Speak. Answer it four ways, then hand it back with 你呢.
Write it: 很 — 彳 first, then 艮

Your turn

- *Say it: nǐ zěnmeyàng* — then answer with *hái xíng*
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我很好

Before you move on

Ask a friend how they are doing. (***nǐ zěnmeyàng.***) Say you are fine. (我很好 — and 很 rises into 好.) What goes in front of an adjective? (**A plain 很**, and no 是.)

Chapter 31

He, She and We

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say he, she, we, you all and they.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 31: I can say he, she, we, you all and they.*

31.1 tā — she; her

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tired, then the Mandarin for not bad.

You'll want to know: tā

tā — "she; her".

> *tā shì wǒ de tóngxué* — She's a classmate of mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tā sounds exactly like the word for he. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: tā*
- *Say it: tā*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ de tóngxué* — She's a classmate of mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tired, then the Mandarin for not bad, then say *tā* again

Before you move on

What does tā mean? ("She; her".) Say it once more.

31.2 他 (tā) — he; him

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for not bad, then the Mandarin for she.

You'll want to know: 他

他 — *tā* — "he; him".

他是我的儿子 *tā shì wǒ de érzi* — He's my son.

The new character, in pieces: 他 — the person piece from 你 on the left, and on the right a three-stroke shape read yě. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

他 (*tā*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tha* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses it 'not I', the other person, and calls this the everyday form of the character. From somebody other than me to he is the usual explanation, but the step itself is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: tā*
- *Say it: tā*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ de érzi* — He's my son.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for not bad, then the Mandarin for she, then say *tā* again

Before you move on

What does 他 mean? ("He; him".) Say it once more.

31.3 他 — the person piece, then yě

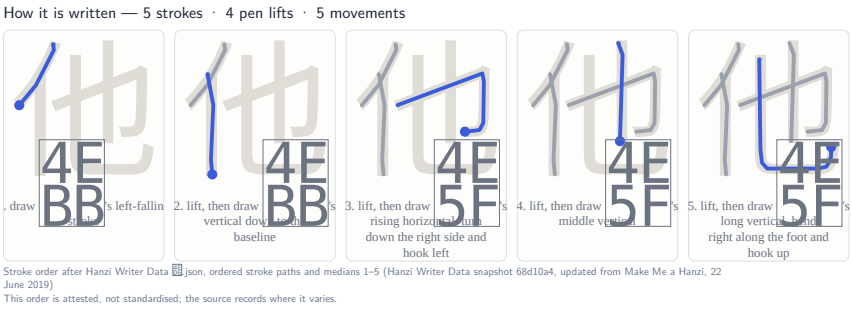
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  亻 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — the person piece, *nǐ*

Script — the person piece, then yě



How 他 is written, stroke by stroke

他

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 亻, two strokes. The same two as in 你: a left-falling stroke, then a vertical down to the foot.

The right piece, three strokes, read yě. A horizontal that runs right, turns down and hooks. A short vertical through the middle of it. Then a long vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up at the end.

2 + 3 = five, and the first two your hand already knows.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 他, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 他 have? (**Five**.) Which piece comes first? (**亻, the person piece, on the left**.) How does the last stroke end? (**It runs along the bottom and hooks up**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 他, pinned stroke paths and medians.

31.4 他们 (tāmen) — they; them

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for she, then the Mandarin for he.

You'll want to know: 他们

他们 — *tāmen* — "they; them".

他们是中国人 *tāmen shì Zhōngguó rén* — They're Chinese.

The new character, in pieces: 们 — the person piece on the left again, and on the right a three-stroke piece read mén, the word for door, which gives the sound. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

他们 (*tāmen*) is built from 他 'he' and the plural ending men, which goes on words for people. No dictionary we use records an older form of the ending, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāmen*
- *Say it: tāmen*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen shì Zhōngguó rén* — They're Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for she, then the Mandarin for he, then say *tāmen* again

Before you move on

What does 他们 mean? ("They; them".) Say it once more.

31.5 们 — the person piece, then a doorway

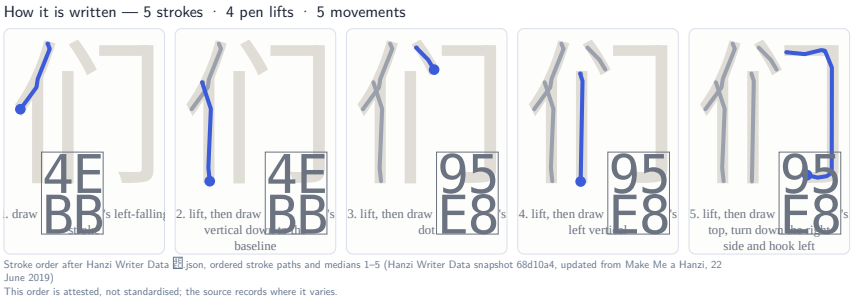
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tāmen* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  他 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tā*, *nǐ*

Script — the person piece, then a doorway



How 们 is written, stroke by stroke

们

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, 亻, two strokes, exactly as in 他 and 你.

The right piece, a doorway, three strokes. A dot at the top left. A vertical down the left side. Then a horizontal across the top that turns down the right side and hooks in at the foot.

2 + 3 = five. The doorway is read mén, and alone it is the word for door; here it gives 们 its sound and loses its tone.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 们, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 们? (**Two** — 亻, then the doorway.) Which stroke of the doorway comes first? (**The dot**.) Which other character opens with the same two strokes? (他, and 你.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 们, pinned stroke paths and medians.

31.6 我们 (wǒmen) — we; us

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for he, then the Mandarin for they.

You'll want to know: 我们

我们 — *wǒmen* — "we; us".

wǒmen hái xíng — We're doing all right.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

我们 (*wǒmen*) is built from 我 'I' and the plural ending men. 我 is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary glosses as what you call yourself; no dictionary we use records an older form of the ending, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǒmen*
- *Say it: wǒmen*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen hái xíng* — We're doing all right.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for he, then the Mandarin for they, then say *wǒmen* again

Before you move on

What does 我们 mean? ("We; us".) Say it once more.

31.7 你们 (nǐmen) — you all; you (more than one)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for they, then the Mandarin for we.

You'll want to know: 你们

你们 — *nǐmen* — "you all; you (more than one)".

nǐmen zěnmeyàng — How are you all doing?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

你们 (*nǐmen*) is built from 你 'you' and the plural ending men. No dictionary we use records an older form of either, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǐmen*
- *Say it: nǐmen*, once more
- *Say it: nǐmen zěnmeyàng* — How are you all doing?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for they, then the Mandarin for we, then say *nǐmen* again

Before you move on

What does 你们 mean? ("You all; you (more than one)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 32

Mum and Dad

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my parents, brothers and sisters.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 32: I can name my parents, brothers and sisters.*

32.1 妈妈 (māma) — mum; mother

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for we, then the Mandarin for you all.

You'll want to know: 妈妈

妈妈 — *māma* — "mum; mother".

> 我妈妈很好 *wǒ māma hěn hǎo* — My mum is well.

The new character, in pieces: 妈 — 女, the woman piece, on the left, and on the right a three-stroke piece read mǎ, the word for horse, which gives the sound as it does in 吗. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

妈妈 (*māma*) is written with a character the Guangyun records as *muX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'mother'. The modern sound is not what *muX* would regularly become, so whether

mā is inherited from it, or is a nursery word written with this character, is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: māma*
- *Say it: māma*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma hěn hǎo* — My mum is well.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for we, then the Mandarin for you all, then say *māma* again

Before you move on

What does 妈妈 mean? ("Mum; mother".) Say it once more.

32.2 妈 — the woman piece, then a horse

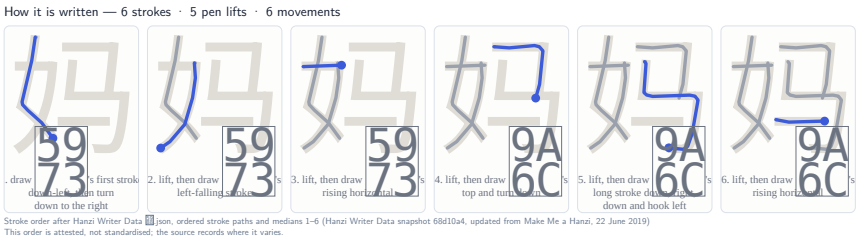
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *māma* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

女 吗

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǚ*, *ma*

Script — the woman piece, then a horse



How 妈 is written, stroke by stroke

妈

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, 女, three strokes, as you wrote it alone, but narrow: the fold that drops and turns, the long left-falling stroke, and last the horizontal, which here rises to the right so it does not cross into the next piece.

The right piece, the horse, three strokes. A horizontal that turns down. A vertical that folds right, folds down again and hooks at the foot. Then a rising stroke across the bottom.

3 + 3 = six. The same horse stands on the right of 吗, which is why the two sound alike.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 妈, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 妈? (**Two** — 女, then the horse.) What does the last stroke of 女 do here? (**It rises to the right**.) Which character you know has the same right piece? (吗.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 妈, pinned stroke paths and medians.

32.3 bàba — dad; father

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for you all, then the Mandarin for mum.

You'll want to know: bàba

bàba — "dad; father".

wǒ bàba xǐhuan kàn shū — My dad likes reading.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàba is inherited from Middle Chinese *baX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where the character is glossed 'father'. Spoken, it is doubled, like the word for mum.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàba*
- *Say it: bàba*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba xǐhuan kàn shū* — My dad likes reading.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for you all, then the Mandarin for mum, then say *bàba* again

Before you move on

What does bàba mean? ("Dad; father".) Say it once more.

32.4 gēge — elder brother

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for mum, then the Mandarin for dad.

You'll want to know: gēge

gēge — "elder brother".

wǒ yǒu yí ge gēge — I've got an older brother.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēge is inherited from Middle Chinese *ka* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary notes that the character was once written for 'song', and that in its own day people used it to call an

elder brother.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēge*
- *Say it: gēge*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒu yí ge gēge* — I've got an older brother.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for mum, then the Mandarin for dad, then say *gēge* again

Before you move on

What does gēge mean? ("Elder brother".) Say it once more.

32.5 jiějie — elder sister

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dad, then the Mandarin for elder brother.

You'll want to know: jiějie

jiějie — "elder sister".

wǒ jiějie shì dàxuésheng — My older sister is at university.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiějie is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsjaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where it is glossed as the word one people used for mother. How it came to mean elder sister is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiějie*
- *Say it: jiějie*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiějie shì dàxuésheng* — My older sister is at university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dad, then the Mandarin for elder brother, then say *jiějie* again

Before you move on

What does jiějie mean? ("Elder sister".) Say it once more.

32.6 dìdi — younger brother

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for elder brother, then the Mandarin for elder sister.

You'll want to know: dìdi

dìdi — "younger brother".

wǒ dìdi bā suì — My little brother is eight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìdi is inherited from Middle Chinese *dejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as the brother born later.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìdi*
- *Say it: dìdi*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ dìdi bā suì* — My little brother is eight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for elder brother, then the Mandarin for elder sister, then say *dìdi* again

Before you move on

What does dìdi mean? ("Younger brother".) Say it once more.

Chapter 33

The Rest of the Family

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about men, women, sisters and children.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 33: I can talk about men, women, sisters and children.*

33.1 男 (nán) — male

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for elder sister, then the Mandarin for younger brother.

You'll want to know: 男

男 — *nán* — "male".

> 我有一个男同学 *wǒ yǒu yí ge nán tóngxué* — One of my classmates is a boy.

The new character, in pieces: 男 — a field on top, built like 日 with a cross inside, and below it a two-stroke piece meaning strength. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

男 (*nán*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *nom* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a man'.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: nán*
- *Say it: nán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒu yí ge nán tóngxué* — One of my classmates is a boy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for elder sister, then the Mandarin for younger brother, then say *nán* again

Before you move on

What does 男 mean? ("Male".) Say it once more.

33.2 男 — a field above, strength below

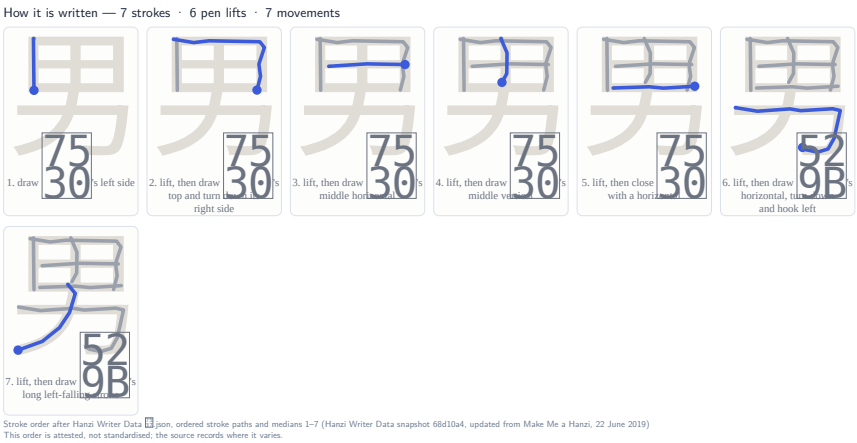
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *nán* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *kǒu*

Script — a field above, strength below



How 男 *is written, stroke by stroke*

男

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, a field, five strokes. A vertical down the left. A horizontal across the top that turns down the right side. The short horizontal across the middle. The short vertical down the middle. Then the horizontal that closes the bottom. It is 日 with a cross inside instead of a single bar.

The bottom piece, strength, two strokes. A horizontal that turns down and hooks to the left, then a long left-falling stroke through it.

5 + 2 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 男, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 男? (**Two** — the field, then strength.) Which character you know does the field look like? (日, with a cross inside.) Which stroke closes the field? (**The bottom horizontal,**

the fifth.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 男, pinned stroke paths and medians.

33.3 男人 (nánrén) — man

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for younger brother, then the Mandarin for male.

You'll want to know: 男人

男人 — *nánrén* — "man".

我家有三个男人 *wǒ jiā yǒu sān ge nánrén* — There are three men in my family.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

男人 (*nánrén*) is built from 男 'male' and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nom* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánrén*
- *Say it: nánrén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā yǒu sān ge nánrén* — There are three men in my family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for younger brother, then the Mandarin for male, then say *nánrén* again

Before you move on

What does 男人 mean? ("Man".) Say it once more.

33.4 女人 (nǚrén) — woman

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for male, then the Mandarin for man.

You'll want to know: 女人

女人 — *nǚrén* — "woman".

我家有四个女人 *wǒ jiā yǒu sì ge nǚrén* — There are four women in my family.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

女人 (*nǚrén*) is built from 女 'female' and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nrjoX* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǚrén*
- *Say it: nǚrén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā yǒu sì ge nǚrén* — There are four women in my family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for male, then the Mandarin for man, then say *nǚrén* again

Before you move on

What does 女人 mean? ("Woman".) Say it once more.

33.5 mèimei — younger sister

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for man, then the Mandarin for woman.

You'll want to know: mèimei

mèimei — "younger sister".

> *wǒ mèimei shì xiǎoxuésheng* — My little sister is at primary school.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mèimei is inherited from Middle Chinese *mwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where it is glossed with the word for sisters.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: mèimei*
- *Say it: mèimei*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mèimei shì xiǎoxuésheng* — My little sister is at primary school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for man, then the Mandarin for woman, then say *mèimei* again

Before you move on

What does mèimei mean? ("Younger sister".) Say it once more.

33.6 háizi — child

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for woman, then the Mandarin for younger sister.

You'll want to know: háizi

háizi — "child".

> *tāmen yǒu sān ge háizi* — They have three children.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

háizi is built from hái 'child' and the noun ending zi. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *hoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a newborn child'; the ending is *tsiX*, 'child', the same piece as the one in 儿子.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: háizi*
- *Say it: háizi*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen yǒu sān ge háizi* — They have three children.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for woman, then the Mandarin for younger sister, then say *háizi* again

Before you move on

What does háizi mean? ("Child".) Say it once more.

Chapter 34

What You Are Called

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask somebody's name and family name, politely too.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 34: I can ask somebody's name and family name, politely too.*

34.1 叫 (jiào) — to be called; to call

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for younger sister, then the Mandarin for child.

You'll want to know: 叫

叫 — *jiào* — "to be called; to call".

> 你叫什么名字 *nǐ jiào shénme míngzi* — What's your name?

The new character, in pieces: 叫 — 口, the mouth piece, small on the left, and on the right two strokes: one that flicks up, and a long vertical. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

叫 (*jiào*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *kewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to call out'. The sense 'to be named' is not given there; from calling a person to what a person is called is a

likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiào*
- *Say it: jiào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ jiào shénme míngzi* — What's your name?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for younger sister, then the Mandarin for child, then say *jiào* again

Before you move on

What does 叫 mean? ("To be called; to call".) Say it once more.

34.2 叫 — a small mouth, then two strokes

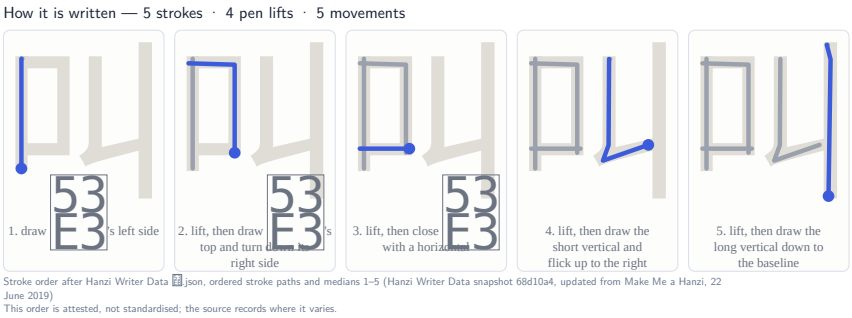
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 吗

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *ma*

Script — a small mouth, then two strokes



How 叫 is written, stroke by stroke

叫

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, 口, three strokes, as in 吗, small and set a little high: the left side, the top that turns down the right, the bottom that closes it.

The right piece, two strokes. A vertical that flicks up to the right at the foot. Then a long vertical, the tallest stroke in the character.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 叫, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 叫? (**Two** — 口, then two strokes.) Which character you know has the same small 口 on the left? (吗.) Which stroke is last? (**The long vertical**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 叫, pinned stroke paths and medians.

34.3 nín — you (polite)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for child, then the Mandarin for to be called.

You'll want to know: nín

nín — "you (polite)".

nín jiào shénme míngzi — May I ask your name?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nín is the polite form of 你, for older people and strangers. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: nín*
- *Say it: nín*, once more
- *Say it: nín jiào shénme míngzi* — May I ask your name?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for child, then the Mandarin for to be called, then say *nín* again

Before you move on

What does nín mean? ("You (polite)".) Say it once more.

34.4 xìng — to have the family name; family name

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be called, then the Mandarin for you (polite).

You'll want to know: xìng

xìng — "to have the family name; family name".

nǐ xìng shénme — What's your family name?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìng is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'clan name'.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìng*
- *Say it: xìng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xìng shénme* — What's your family name?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be called, then the Mandarin for you (polite), then say *xìng* again

Before you move on

What does xìng mean? ("To have the family name; family name".) Say it once more.

34.5 rènshi — to know someone; to recognise

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for you (polite), then the Mandarin for to have the family name.

You'll want to know: rènshi

rènshi — "to know someone; to recognise".

wǒ rènshi tā — I know him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rènshi is built from two old words for knowing, both inherited from Middle Chinese: *nyinH*, which the Guangyun glosses with the second, and *syik*, 'to know' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: rènshi*
- *Say it: rènshi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ rènshi tā* — I know him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for you (polite), then the Mandarin for to have the family name, then say *rènshi* again

Before you move on

What does rènshi mean? ("To know someone; to recognise".) Say it once more.

34.6 péngyou — friend

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have the family name, then the Mandarin for to know someone.

You'll want to know: péngyou

péngyou — "friend".

tā shì wǒ de péngyou — He's a friend of mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

péngyou is built from two words for companions, both inherited from Middle Chinese: *bong* 'a band of companions' and *hjuwX* 'friend'

(Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as people of one mind.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: péngyou*
- *Say it: péngyou*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ de péngyou* — He's a friend of mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have the family name, then the Mandarin for to know someone, then say *péngyou* again

Before you move on

What does péngyou mean? ("Friend".) Say it once more.

Chapter 35

Who Does What

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what people do and where somebody lives.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 35: I can say what people do and where somebody lives.*

35.1 gōngzuò — to work; job

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to know someone, then the Mandarin for friend.

You'll want to know: gōngzuò

gōngzuò — "to work; job".

> *wǒ jiějie gōngzuò, wǒ shàngxué* — My sister works; I go to school.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngzuò is built from gōng 'craft' and zuò 'to do', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *tsak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'office' and 'skill', the second 'to do'.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngzuò*
- *Say it: gōngzuò*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiějie gōngzuò, wǒ shàngxué* — My sister works; I go to school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to know someone, then the Mandarin for friend, then say *gōngzuò* again

Before you move on

What does gōngzuò mean? ("To work; job".) Say it once more.

35.2 lǎo — old

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for friend, then the Mandarin for to work.

You'll want to know: lǎo

lǎo — "old".

tā shì wǒ de lǎo tóngxué — He's an old classmate of mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *lawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'aged'.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǎo*
- *Say it: lǎo*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ de lǎo tóngxué* — He's an old classmate of mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for friend, then the Mandarin for to work, then say *lǎo* again

Before you move on

What does lǎo mean? ("Old".) Say it once more.

35.3 lǎoshī — teacher

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to work, then the Mandarin for old.

You'll want to know: lǎoshī

lǎoshī — "teacher".

wǒ māma shì lǎoshī — My mum is a teacher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǎoshī is built from lǎo 'old, respected' and shī 'teacher', both inherited from Middle Chinese: *lawX*, glossed 'aged', and *srij*, glossed 'a model to follow' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǎoshī*
- *Say it: lǎoshī*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ māma shì lǎoshī* — My mum is a teacher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to work, then the Mandarin for old, then say *lǎoshī* again

Before you move on

What does lǎoshī mean? ("Teacher".) Say it once more.

35.4 xiānsheng — Mr; sir; husband

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for old, then the Mandarin for teacher.

You'll want to know: xiānsheng

xiānsheng — "Mr; sir; husband".

tā xiānsheng shì lǎoshī — Her husband is a teacher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiānsheng is built from xiān 'before' and 生 'to be born, to grow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sen* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'The one born first' is the usual explanation of how it came to mean an older man to respect, and then Mr or husband; the path is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiānsheng*
- *Say it: xiānsheng*, once more
- *Say it: tā xiānsheng shì lǎoshī* — Her husband is a teacher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for old, then the Mandarin for teacher, then say *xiānsheng* again

Before you move on

What does xiānsheng mean? ("Mr; sir; husband".) Say it once more.

35.5 zhù — to live somewhere; to stay

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for teacher, then the Mandarin for sir.

You'll want to know: zhù

zhù — "to live somewhere; to stay".

tā zhù wǒ jiā — He's staying at our place.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhù is inherited from Middle Chinese *drjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to stop, to stay'. Staying somewhere becoming living there is a likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhù*
- *Say it: zhù*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhù wǒ jiā* — He's staying at our place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for teacher, then the Mandarin for sir, then say *zhù* again

Before you move on

What does zhù mean? ("To live somewhere; to stay".) Say it once more.

Chapter 36

Where People Come From

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where somebody comes from and ask which country.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 36: I can say where somebody comes from and ask which country.*

36.1 来 (lái) — to come

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sir, then the Mandarin for to live somewhere.

You'll want to know: 来

来 — *lái* — "to come".

> 妈妈来了 *māma lái le* — Mum's here.

The new character, in pieces: 来 — one piece built from the top down: a short bar, a dot and a short stroke under it, a long bar, a vertical through it, and two strokes spreading at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

来 (*lái*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to arrive'.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: lái*
- *Say it: lái*, once more
- *Say it: māma lái le* — Mum's here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sir, then the Mandarin for to live somewhere, then say *lái* again

Before you move on

What does 来 mean? ("To come".) Say it once more.

36.2 来 — one piece, top to bottom

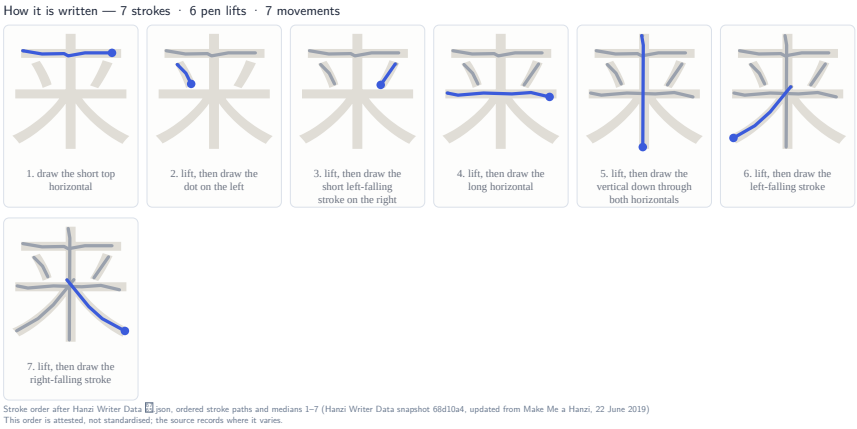
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lái* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

大 十

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *shí*

Script — one piece, top to bottom



How 来 *is written, stroke by stroke*

来

One piece, three layers, top to bottom.

The top layer, three strokes. A short horizontal. Under it, a dot on the left and a short left-falling stroke on the right, leaning in toward each other.

The middle, two strokes. A long horizontal, then the vertical through the middle of everything, from the very top, through both bars, to the foot.

The foot, two strokes. A left-falling stroke and a right-falling stroke, spreading out from the vertical like the legs of 大.

3 + 2 + 2 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 来, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many layers in 来? (**Three**.) Which comes first, the dot or the short left-falling stroke? (**The dot**.) Which character you know ends with the same two spreading strokes? (大.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 来, pinned stroke paths and medians.

36.3 Měiguó — America; the United States

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to live somewhere, then the Mandarin for to come.

You'll want to know: Měiguó

Měiguó — "America; the United States".

Měiguó hěn dà — America is huge.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Měiguó is built from měi 'beautiful' and 国 'country', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mijX* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Měi is usually explained as standing for a syllable of the name America.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: Měiguó*
- *Say it: Měiguó*, once more
- *Say it: Měiguó hěn dà* — America is huge.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to live somewhere, then the Mandarin for to come, then say *Měiguó* again

Before you move on

What does Měiguó mean? ("America; the United States".) Say it once more.

36.4 Yīngguó — Britain; the United Kingdom

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come, then the Mandarin for the United States.

You'll want to know: Yīngguó

Yīngguó — "Britain; the United Kingdom".

Yīngguó hěn xiǎo — Britain is quite small.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Yīngguó is built from yīng 'flower, fine' and 国 'country', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jaeng* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Yīng is usually explained as standing for the first syllable of England.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *Yīngguó*
- *Say it:* *Yīngguó*, once more
- *Say it:* *Yīngguó hěn xiǎo* — Britain is quite small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come, then the Mandarin for the United States, then say *Yīngguó* again

Before you move on

What does Yīngguó mean? ("Britain; the United Kingdom".) Say it once more.

36.5 Běijīng — Beijing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the United States, then the Mandarin for the United Kingdom.

You'll want to know: Běijīng

Běijīng — "Beijing".

wǒmen lái Běijīng le — We've come to Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Běijīng is built from běi 'north' and jīng 'capital', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pok* and *kjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the northern capital.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: Běijīng*
- *Say it: Běijīng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen lái Běijīng le* — We've come to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the United States, then the Mandarin for the United Kingdom, then say *Běijīng* again

Before you move on

What does Běijīng mean? ("Beijing".) Say it once more.

36.6 nǎ — which

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the United Kingdom, then the Mandarin for Beijing.

You'll want to know: nǎ

nǎ — "which".

nǐ shì nǎ guó rén — Which country are you from?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nǎ has no older form in any dictionary we use, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǎ*
- *Say it: nǎ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shì nǎ guó rén* — Which country are you from?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the United Kingdom, then the Mandarin for Beijing, then say *nǎ* again

Before you move on

What does nǎ mean? ("Which".) Say it once more.

36.7 Looking back: from He, She and We to Where People Come From

Say the Mandarin for she and he.

Your turn

- *Say it:* she, he, they, we, you all
- *Say it:* mum, dad, elder brother, elder sister, younger brother
- *Say it:* male, man, woman, younger sister, child
- *Say it:* to be called, you (polite), to have the family name, to know someone, friend
- *Say it:* to work, old, teacher, sir, to live somewhere
- *Say it:* to come, the United States, the United Kingdom, Beijing, which

- *Read it:* 他 们 妈 男 叫 来 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

She? (*tā.*) He? (他, *tā.*) They? (他们, *tāmen.*) We? (我们, *wǒmen.*) You all? (你们, *nǐmen.*) Mum? (妈妈, *māma.*) Dad? (*bàba.*) Elder brother? (*gēge.*) Elder sister? (*jiějie.*) Younger brother? (*dìdi.*) Male? (男, *nán.*) Man? (男人, *nánrén.*) Woman? (女人, *nǚrén.*) Younger sister? (*mèimei.*) Child? (*háizi.*) To be called? (叫, *jiào.*) You (polite)? (*nín.*) To have the family name? (*xìng.*) To know someone? (*rènshi.*) Friend? (*péngyou.*) To work? (*gōngzuò.*) Old? (*lǎo.*) Teacher? (*lǎoshī.*) Sir? (*xiānsheng.*) To live somewhere? (*zhù.*) To come? (来, *lái.*) The United States? (*Měiguó.*) The United Kingdom? (*Yīngguó.*) Beijing? (*Běijīng.*) Which? (*nǎ.*)

Chapter 37

This One and That One

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can point things out as this one, that one and which one.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 37: I can point things out as this one, that one and which one.*

37.1 这 (zhè) — this

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for Beijing, then the Mandarin for which.

You'll want to know: 这

这 — *zhè* — "this".

> 这是我的书 *zhè shì wǒ de shū* — This is my book.

The new character, in pieces: 这 — 文, from 中文, and a walking piece that runs under it from the left. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

这 (*zhè*) is written with an old character that the Guangyun records as *ngjenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to meet'. That is a different word: *ngjenH* would not become zhè. How the character came to write the word for this is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhè*
- *Say it: zhè*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de shū* — This is my book.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for Beijing, then the Mandarin for which, then say *zhè* again

Before you move on

What does 这 mean? ("This".) Say it once more.

37.2 这 — 文, then the walking piece

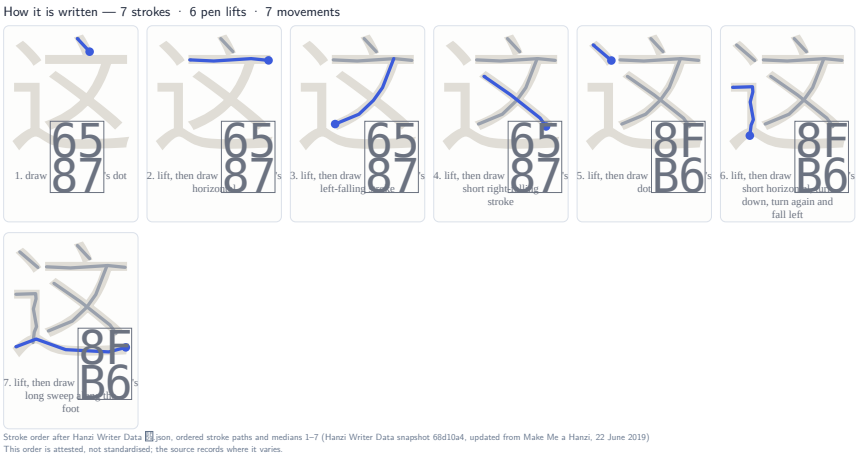
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  文 书

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wén*, *shū*

Script — 文, then the walking piece



How 这 *is written, stroke by stroke*

这

Two pieces, and the one underneath goes last. The walking piece wraps the bottom-left, but it is written after what it carries.

The top-right piece, 文**, four strokes**, as in 中文: a dot, a horizontal, a left-falling stroke and a right-falling stroke crossing it.

The walking piece, three strokes. A dot. A stroke that runs across, folds down and folds again, ending in a short fall. Then a long flat sweep along the bottom, under 文, out to the right.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 这, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 这? (**Two** — 文, then the walking piece.)
Which goes first? (文, even though the walking piece is on the left.)
Which stroke is last? (**The long sweep along the bottom.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 这, pinned stroke paths and medians.

37.3 这个 (zhège) — this one

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for which, then the Mandarin for this.

You'll want to know: 这个

这个 — *zhège* — "this one".

这个人叫什么名字 *zhège rén jiào shénme míngzi* — What's this person's name?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

这个 (*zhège*) is built from 这 'this' and the measure word 个.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhège*
- *Say it: zhège*, once more
- *Say it: zhège rén jiào shénme míngzi* — What's this person's name?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for which, then the Mandarin for this, then say *zhège* again

Before you move on

What does 这个 mean? ("This one".) Say it once more.

37.4 那 (nà) — that

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for this, then the Mandarin for this one.

You'll want to know: 那

那 — *nà* — "that".

那是我的家 *nà shì wǒ de jiā* — That's my home.

The new character, in pieces: 那 — a four-stroke piece on the left, and on the right a two-stroke piece shaped like an ear. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

那 (*nà*) is an old character: the Guangyun records it as *na* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'how, what'. The sense 'that' is not given there, so how it came to mean that is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: nà*
- *Say it: nà*, once more
- *Say it: nà shì wǒ de jiā* — That's my home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for this, then the Mandarin for this one, then say *nà* again

Before you move on

What does 那 mean? ("That".) Say it once more.

37.5 那 — four strokes, then an ear

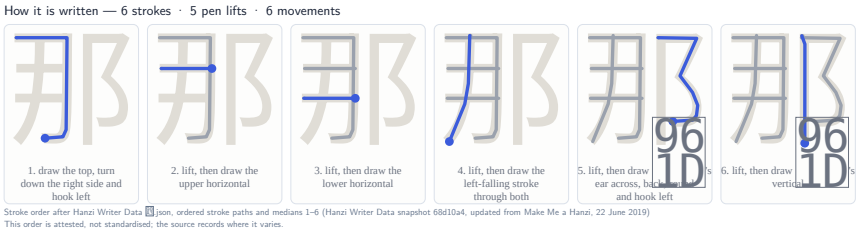
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *nà* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

这 二

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhè*, *èr*

Script — four strokes, then an ear



How 那 *is written, stroke by stroke*

那

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, four strokes. A horizontal that turns down and hooks. Two short horizontals inside it. Then a left-falling stroke from the top, down through them all.

The ear, two strokes. One stroke that runs right, loops down twice like a folded ear and hooks. Then a long vertical down its left edge.

4 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 那, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 那? (**Two** — four strokes, then the ear.) Which stroke of the left piece is last? (**The left-falling stroke through it all.**) Which is the last stroke of the character? (**The long vertical.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 那, pinned stroke paths and medians.

37.6 nǎge — which one

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for this one, then the Mandarin for that.

You'll want to know: nǎge

nǎge — "which one".

nǐ xǐhuan nǎge — Which one do you like?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nǎge is built from nǎ 'which' and the measure word 个.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǎge*
- *Say it: nǎge*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐhuan nǎge* — Which one do you like?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for this one, then the Mandarin for that, then say *nǎge* again

Before you move on

What does nǎge mean? ("Which one".) Say it once more.

37.7 那个 (nàge) — that one

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for that, then the Mandarin for which one.

You'll want to know: 那个

那个 — *nàge* — "that one".

我喜欢那个 *wǒ xǐhuan nàge* — I like that one.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

那个 (*nàge*) is built from 那 'that' and the measure word 个.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: nàge*
- *Say it: nàge*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan nàge* — I like that one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for that, then the Mandarin for which one, then say *nàge* again

Before you move on

What does 那个 mean? ("That one".) Say it once more.

Chapter 38

Eating

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I eat and ask what somebody likes to eat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 38: I can say what I eat and ask what somebody likes to eat.*

38.1 吃 (chī) — to eat

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for which one, then the Mandarin for that one.

You'll want to know: 吃

吃 — *chī* — "to eat".

> 你吃什么 *nǐ chī shénme* — What are you having?

The new character, in pieces: 吃 — 口, the mouth piece, on the left, and on the right three strokes: a short fall, a short bar, and one long stroke that runs across, drops and hooks up. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

吃 (*chī*) is probably inherited from Middle Chinese *khek*, which the Guangyun glosses 'to eat' and writes with a different character; there 吃 itself is *kj+t*, 'to stammer' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

How the word and this character came together is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chī*
- *Say it: chī*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ chī shénme* — What are you having?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for which one, then the Mandarin for that one, then say *chī* again

Before you move on

What does 吃 mean? ("To eat".) Say it once more.

38.2 吃 — a mouth, then three strokes

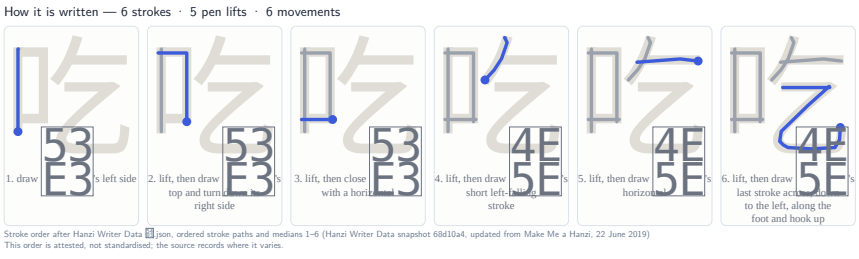
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

口 叫

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *jiào*

Script — a mouth, then three strokes



How 吃 is written, stroke by stroke

吃

Two pieces, left before right.
The left piece, 口, three strokes, small, as in 叫.
The right piece, three strokes. A short left-falling stroke. A short horizontal under it. Then one long stroke: across, down, bending right along the bottom and hooking up.
3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 吃, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 吃? (**Two** — 口, then three strokes.) Which character from the last chapters also has a small 口 on the left? (叫.) How does the last stroke end? (**It hooks up**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 吃, pinned stroke paths and medians.

38.3 饭 (fàn) — cooked rice; meal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for that one, then the Mandarin for to eat.

You'll want to know: 饭

饭 — *fàn* — "cooked rice; meal".

你吃饭了吗 *nǐ chī fàn le ma* — Have you eaten?

The new character, in pieces: 饭 — a three-stroke food piece on the left, and a four-stroke piece on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

饭 (*fàn*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'cooked grain'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàn*
- *Say it: fàn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ chī fàn le ma* — Have you eaten?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for that one, then the Mandarin for to eat, then say *fàn* again

Before you move on

What does 饭 mean? ("Cooked rice; meal".) Say it once more.

38.4 饭 — the food piece, then four strokes

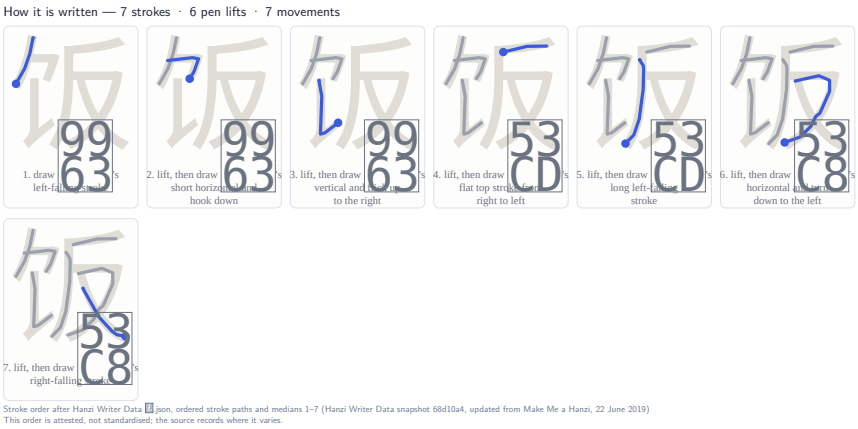
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *fàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  吃 了

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *chī*, *le*

Script — the food piece, then four strokes



How 饭 *is written, stroke by stroke*

饭

Two pieces, left before right.

The food piece, three strokes. A left-falling stroke. A short horizontal that hooks down at its end. A vertical that flicks up to the right at the foot.

The right piece, four strokes. A short left-falling stroke along the top. A long left-falling stroke down the left. A horizontal that turns and falls to the left. Then a right-falling stroke across it.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 饭, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 饭? (**Two** — the food piece, then four strokes.)
How does the food piece end? (**With a vertical that flicks up**.)
Which stroke is last? (**The right-falling stroke**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 饭, pinned stroke paths and medians.

38.5 mǐfàn — cooked rice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to eat, then the Mandarin for meal.

You'll want to know: mǐfàn

mǐfàn — "cooked rice".

wǒ xǐhuan chī mǐfàn — I like rice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǐfàn is built from mǐ 'husked grain' and 饭 'cooked grain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mejX* and *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǐfàn*
- *Say it: mǐfàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan chī mǐfàn* — I like rice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to eat, then the Mandarin for meal, then say *mǐfàn* again

Before you move on

What does mǐfàn mean? ("Cooked rice".) Say it once more.

38.6 è — hungry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for meal, then the Mandarin for cooked rice.

You'll want to know: è

è — "hungry".

wǒ hěn è — I'm starving.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

è is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'not full'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: è*
- *Say it: è*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn è* — I'm starving.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for meal, then the Mandarin for cooked rice, then say *è* again

Before you move on

What does è mean? ("Hungry".) Say it once more.

38.7 cài — dish of food; vegetable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cooked rice, then the Mandarin for hungry.

You'll want to know: cài

cài — "dish of food; vegetable".

nǐ xǐhuan chī shénme cài — What sort of food do you like?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cài is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as any plant that can be eaten.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: cài*
- *Say it: cài*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐhuan chī shénme cài* — What sort of food do you like?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cooked rice, then the Mandarin for hungry, then say *cài* again

Before you move on

What does cài mean? ("Dish of food; vegetable".) Say it once more.

Chapter 39

Drinking

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I drink and ask somebody what they would like.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 39: I can say what I drink and ask somebody what they would like.*

39.1 喝 (hē) — to drink

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hungry, then the Mandarin for dish of food.

You'll want to know: 喝

喝 — *hē* — "to drink".

> 你喝什么 *nǐ hē shénme* — What would you like to drink?

The new character, in pieces: 喝 — 口 on the left; on the right 日 on top of a wrap with a small shape inside it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

喝 (*hē*) is an old character: the Guangyun records it as *xat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to shout at'. The sense 'to drink' is not given there, so how it came to mean drink is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: hē*
- *Say it: hē*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ hē shénme* — What would you like to drink?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hungry, then the Mandarin for dish of food, then say *hē* again

Before you move on

What does 喝 mean? ("To drink".) Say it once more.

39.2 喝 — a mouth, a sun and a wrap

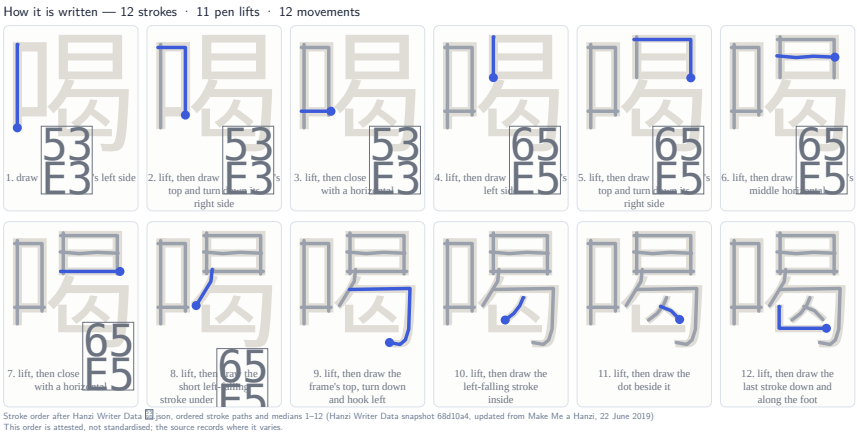
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *hē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

口 日 吃

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *rì*, *chī*

Script — a mouth, a sun and a wrap



How 喝 *is written, stroke by stroke*

喝

Three pieces: 口 on the left, then 日, then the wrap under it. Do not count to twelve; count three.

口, three strokes, small, as in 吃.

日, four strokes, short and wide, at the top right.

The wrap, five strokes. A short left-falling stroke. A horizontal that turns down and hooks, making a roof. Inside it, a small left-falling stroke and a dot. Then a corner stroke, down and along, closing them in.

3 + 4 + 5 = twelve, and the first seven are two shapes you know.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 喝, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 喝? (**Three** — 口, 日, and the wrap.) How many strokes before the wrap starts? (**Seven**.) What goes inside the wrap? (**A small left-falling stroke and a dot**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 喝, pinned stroke paths and medians.

39.3 水 (shuǐ) — water

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dish of food, then the Mandarin for to drink.

You'll want to know: 水

水 — *shuǐ* — "water".

我喜欢喝水 *wǒ xǐhuan hē shuǐ* — I like drinking water.

The new character, in pieces: 水 — a hooked vertical down the middle, one stroke on its left that runs across and falls away, and two strokes on its right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

水 (*shuǐ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *sywijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as one of the five elements, the one of the north, and as 'level'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuǐ*
- *Say it: shuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan hē shuǐ* — I like drinking water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dish of food, then the Mandarin for to drink, then say *shuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 水 mean? ("Water".) Say it once more.

39.4 水 — the middle first, then the sides

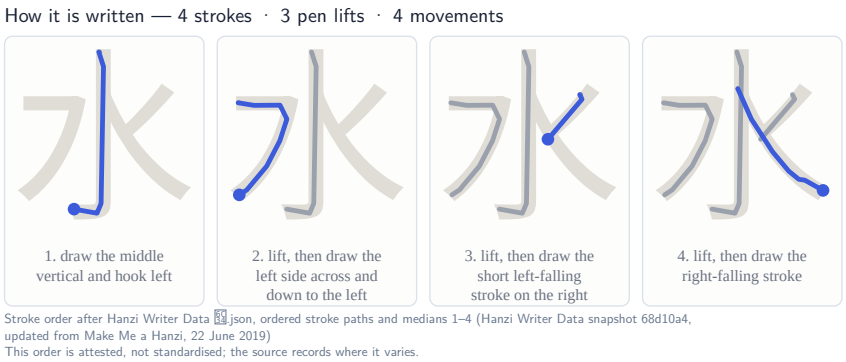
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shuǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

小 喝

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xiǎo*, *hē*

Script — the middle first, then the sides



How 水 *is written, stroke by stroke*

水

One piece: the middle, then left, then right.

The middle, one stroke. A long vertical that hooks to the left at the foot, as in 小.

The left side, one stroke. A short horizontal that turns and falls away to the lower left.

The right side, two strokes. A short left-falling stroke toward the middle, then a long right-falling stroke out to the lower right.

1 + 1 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 水, all four, with the model in front of you

- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which stroke of 水 comes first? (**The hooked vertical down the middle.**) Which character you know also starts in the middle? (小.) How many strokes on the right? (**Two.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 水, pinned stroke paths and medians.

39.5 kě — thirsty

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to drink, then the Mandarin for water.

You'll want to know: kě

kě — "thirsty".

nǐ kě ma — Are you thirsty?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kě is inherited from Middle Chinese *khat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'hunger and thirst'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: kě*
- *Say it: kě*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ kě ma* — Are you thirsty?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to drink, then the Mandarin for water, then say *kě* again

Before you move on

What does kě mean? (“Thirsty”.) Say it once more.

39.6 niúnǎi — milk

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for water, then the Mandarin for thirsty.

You’ll want to know: niúnǎi

niúnǎi — “milk”.

háizi xǐhuan hē niúnǎi — Children like milk.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niúnǎi is built from niú ’cattle’ and nǎi ’milk’. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’a large beast’. The second is probably the word the Guangyun records as *nreaX*, glossed ’milk’, under another way of writing the character.

What you’ve built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: niúnǎi*
- *Say it: niúnǎi*, once more
- *Say it: háizi xǐhuan hē niúnǎi* — Children like milk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for water, then the Mandarin for thirsty, then say *niúnǎi* again

Before you move on

What does niúnǎi mean? ("Milk".) Say it once more.

39.7 chá — tea

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for thirsty, then the Mandarin for milk.

You'll want to know: chá

chá — "tea".

nǐ hē chá ma — Would you like some tea?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chá is inherited from Middle Chinese *drae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as leaves gathered in spring and made into a drink.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chá*
- *Say it: chá*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ hē chá ma* — Would you like some tea?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for thirsty, then the Mandarin for milk, then say *chá* again

Before you move on

What does chá mean? ("Tea".) Say it once more.

Chapter 40

Fruit, Bread and Eggs

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I buy and name fruit, bread and eggs.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 40: I can say what I buy and name fruit, bread and eggs.*

40.1 买 (mǎi) — to buy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for milk, then the Mandarin for tea.

You'll want to know: 买

买 — *mǎi* — "to buy".

你们买水吗 *nǐmen mǎi shuǐ ma* — Are you buying water?

The new character, in pieces: 买 — a lid with two dots under it, and below them a shape like 大 with its last stroke cut down to a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

买 (*mǎi*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *meaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to trade at market'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎi*
- *Say it: mǎi*, once more
- *Say it: nǐmen mǎi shuǐ ma* — Are you buying water?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for milk, then the Mandarin for tea, then say *mǎi* again

Before you move on

What does 买 mean? ("To buy".) Say it once more.

40.2 买 — a lid, two dots, and a cut-down 大

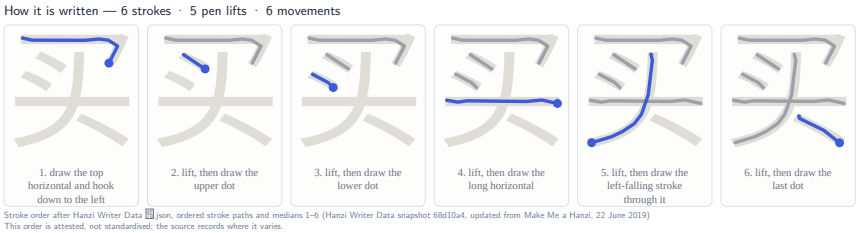
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *mǎi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

大 水

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *shuǐ*

Script — a lid, two dots, and a cut-down 大



How 买 is written, stroke by stroke

买

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, three strokes. A horizontal that hooks down at its right end, like a lid. Then two dots under it, one above the other.

The bottom piece, three strokes. A long horizontal, a left-falling stroke through it, and a dot on the right. It is 大 with its last stroke cut down to a dot.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 买, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 买? (**Two** — the lid with its dots, then the cut-down 大.) What is under the lid? (**Two dots**.) What is the last stroke? (**A dot**, where 大 has a long fall.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 买, pinned stroke paths and medians.

40.3 píngguǒ — apple

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tea, then the Mandarin for to buy.

You'll want to know: píngguǒ

píngguǒ — "apple".

wǒ mǎi le sān ge píngguǒ — I bought three apples.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píngguǒ is built from píng and guǒ 'fruit'. Guǒ is inherited from Middle Chinese *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'fruit of a tree'; the first character is listed there as *bjaeng*, a name for

several plants, duckweed among them, and how it came to name the apple is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: píngguǒ*
- *Say it: píngguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎi le sān ge píngguǒ* — I bought three apples.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tea, then the Mandarin for to buy, then say *píngguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does píngguǒ mean? ("Apple".) Say it once more.

40.4 shuǐguǒ — fruit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to buy, then the Mandarin for apple.

You'll want to know: shuǐguǒ

shuǐguǒ — "fruit".

wǒ xǐhuan chī shuǐguǒ — I like fruit.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Tone: *shuǐguǒ* is two third tones in a row, so *shuǐ* rises and only *guǒ* keeps the dip. The spelling does not show the change; your voice makes it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuǐguǒ is built from 水 'water' and guǒ 'fruit', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sywijX* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuǐguǒ*
- *Say it: shuǐguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan chī shuǐguǒ* — I like fruit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to buy, then the Mandarin for apple, then say *shuǐguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does shuǐguǒ mean? ("Fruit".) Say it once more.

40.5 miànbāo — bread

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for apple, then the Mandarin for fruit.

You'll want to know: miànbāo

miànbāo — "bread".

wǒ chī le yí ge miànbāo — I had a bread roll.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

miànbāo is built from miàn 'flour' and bāo 'to wrap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *menH* and *paew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: miànbāo*
- *Say it: miànbāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chī le yí ge miànbāo* — I had a bread roll.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for apple, then the Mandarin for fruit, then say *miànbāo* again

Before you move on

What does miànbāo mean? ("Bread".) Say it once more.

40.6 jīdàn — egg

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fruit, then the Mandarin for bread.

You'll want to know: jīdàn

jīdàn — "egg".

tā xǐhuan chī jīdàn — He likes eggs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīdàn is built from jī 'chicken' and dàn 'egg'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *kej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary calls the animal that knows the hour; no dictionary we use records an older form of the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīdàn*
- *Say it: jīdàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā xǐhuan chī jīdàn* — He likes eggs.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fruit, then the Mandarin for bread, then say *jīdàn* again

Before you move on

What does jīdàn mean? (“Egg”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 41

Paying

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how much something costs and say how much I want.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 41: I can ask how much something costs and say how much I want.*

41.1 多少 (duōshao) — how much; how many

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bread, then the Mandarin for egg.

You'll want to know: 多少

多少 — *duōshao* — "how much; how many".

> 你买了多少 *nǐ mǎi le duōshao* — How many did you buy?

The new character, in pieces: 多 — one three-stroke piece twice, one above the other; 少 — 小, the small piece, without its hook, and one long sweep below it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

多少 (*duōshao*) is built from 多 'many' and 少 'few', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ta* and *syewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): many-few, asked as a question.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: duōshao*
- *Say it: duōshao*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ mǎi le duōshao* — How many did you buy?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bread, then the Mandarin for egg, then say *duōshao* again

Before you move on

What does 多少 mean? ("How much; how many".) Say it once more.

41.2 多 — the same three strokes, twice

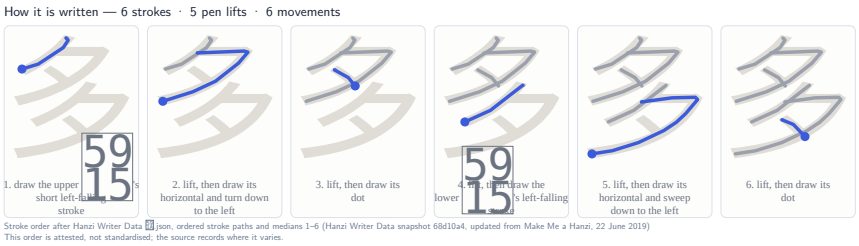
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *duōshao* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  了 买

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *le*, *mǎi*

Script — the same three strokes, twice



How 多 is written, stroke by stroke

多

One shape, twice: top, then bottom.

The shape, three strokes. A short left-falling stroke. A horizontal that turns and falls to the lower left. A dot inside the turn.

Make it again below, a little larger and a little to the right, so the two lean together.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 多, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in one half of 多? (**Three**.) Which half is larger? (**The lower one**.) Where does the dot go? (**Inside the turn**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 多, pinned stroke paths and medians.

41.3 少 — 小 without its hook, and a sweep

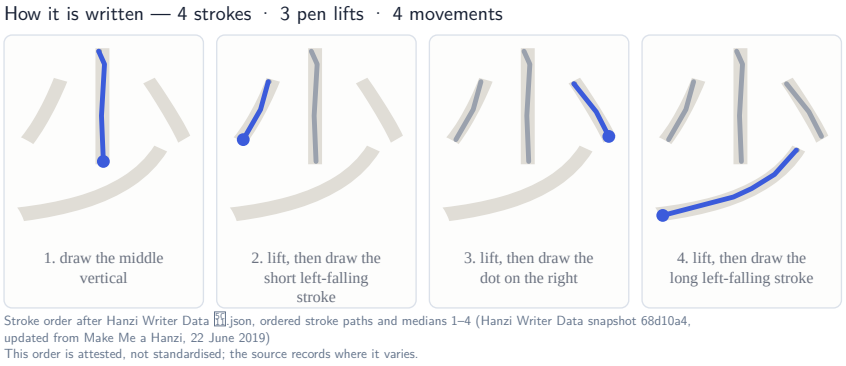
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *duōshao* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

小 买

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xiǎo*, *mǎi*

Script — 小 without its hook, and a sweep



How 少 is written, stroke by stroke

少

One piece, built on 小.

Three strokes like 小. A vertical down the middle, but this time with no hook at the foot. A short stroke falling to the left. A dot on the right.

One more stroke. A long left-falling sweep from the right, under the vertical.

3 + 1 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 少, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which character you know is inside 少? (小.) What does the middle vertical lose? (**Its hook**.) Which stroke is last? (**The long sweep to the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 少, pinned stroke paths and medians.

41.4 qián — money

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for egg, then the Mandarin for how much.

You'll want to know: qián

qián — "money".

zhège duōshao qián — How much is this one?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qián is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'coin'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: qián*
- *Say it: qián*, once more
- *Say it: zhège duōshao qián* — How much is this one?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for egg, then the Mandarin for how much, then say *qián* again

Before you move on

What does qián mean? ("Money".) Say it once more.

41.5 kuài — yuan; lump

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how much, then the Mandarin for money.

You'll want to know: kuài

kuài — "yuan; lump".

> *nàge shí kuài qián* — That one is ten yuan.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

kuài is the spoken word for the yuan: a price is a number, then *kuài*, then *qián*, which can be left off.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kuài is inherited from Middle Chinese *khwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a clod of earth'. Its use for counting money is not given there, so how it took that job is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuài*
- *Say it: kuài*, once more
- *Say it: nàge shí kuài qián* — That one is ten yuan.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how much, then the Mandarin for money, then say *kuài* again

Before you move on

What does kuài mean? ("Yuan; lump".) Say it once more.

41.6 tài — too; too much

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for money, then the Mandarin for yuan.

You'll want to know: tài

tài — "too; too much".

tài xiǎo le — That's too small.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
tài usually brings a *le* at the end of the sentence with it: *tài xiǎo le*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tài is inherited from Middle Chinese *thajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'extreme' and 'great'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: tài*
- *Say it: tài*, once more
- *Say it: tài xiǎo le* — That's too small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for money, then the Mandarin for yuan, then say *tài* again

Before you move on

What does tài mean? ("Too; too much".) Say it once more.

41.7 yào — to want; to ask for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for yuan, then the Mandarin for too.

You'll want to know: yào

yào — "to want; to ask for".

nǐ yào duōshao — How many would you like?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yào is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to bind by agreement'. The sense 'to want' is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: yào*
- *Say it: yào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yào duōshao* — How many would you like?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for yuan, then the Mandarin for too, then say *yào* again

Before you move on

What does yào mean? ("To want; to ask for".) Say it once more.

Chapter 42

In the Shop

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what a shop sells and whether it is cheap or dear.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 42: I can say what a shop sells and whether it is cheap or dear.*

42.1 dōngxi — thing; things

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for too, then the Mandarin for to want.

You'll want to know: dōngxi

dōngxi — "thing; things".

> *nǐ mǎi shénme dōngxi* — What are you buying?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dōngxi is built from dōng 'east' and xī 'west', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tuwng* and *sej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How east-and-west came to mean a thing is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōngxi*
- *Say it: dōngxi*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ mǎi shénme dōngxi* — What are you buying?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for too, then the Mandarin for to want, then say *dōngxi* again

Before you move on

What does dōngxi mean? ("Thing; things".) Say it once more.

42.2 mài — to sell

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to want, then the Mandarin for thing.

You'll want to know: mài

mài — "to sell".

tāmen mài shénme — What do they sell?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mài is inherited from Middle Chinese *meaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to put goods out'. It differs from the word for buy only in its tone.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: mài*
- *Say it: mài*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen mài shénme* — What do they sell?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to want, then the Mandarin for thing, then say *mài* again

Before you move on

What does mài mean? ("To sell".) Say it once more.

42.3 shāngdiàn — shop

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for thing, then the Mandarin for to sell.

You'll want to know: shāngdiàn

shāngdiàn — "shop".

zhège shāngdiàn hěn xiǎo — This shop is tiny.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāngdiàn is built from shāng, usually explained as 'trade', and diàn 'shop', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syang* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary explains the second as a place where goods are kept and sold.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāngdiàn*
- *Say it: shāngdiàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège shāngdiàn hěn xiǎo* — This shop is tiny.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for thing, then the Mandarin for to sell, then say *shāngdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does shāngdiàn mean? ("Shop".) Say it once more.

42.4 piányi — cheap

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sell, then the Mandarin for shop.

You'll want to know: piányi

piányi — "cheap".

zhège hěn piányi — This one's cheap.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

piányi is built from two old words, both inherited from Middle Chinese: *bjien* 'at ease' and *ngje* 'fitting' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The sense 'cheap' is not given there, so how the pair came to mean it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: piányi*
- *Say it: piányi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège hěn piányi* — This one's cheap.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sell, then the Mandarin for shop, then say *piányi* again

Before you move on

What does piányi mean? ("Cheap".) Say it once more.

42.5 guì — expensive

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for shop, then the Mandarin for cheap.

You'll want to know: guì

guì — "expensive".

nàge tài guì le — That one's too expensive.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guì is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjw+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'honoured, high'. The price sense is not given there; from valued to costly is a likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: guì*
- *Say it: guì*, once more

- *Say it: nàge tài guì le* — That one's too expensive.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for shop, then the Mandarin for cheap, then say *guì* again

Before you move on

What does guì mean? ("Expensive".) Say it once more.

42.6 Looking back: from This One and That One to In the Shop

Say the Mandarin for this and this one.

Your turn

- *Say it:* this, this one, that, which one, that one
- *Say it:* to eat, meal, cooked rice, hungry, dish of food
- *Say it:* to drink, water, thirsty, milk, tea
- *Say it:* to buy, apple, fruit, bread, egg
- *Say it:* how much, money, yuan, too, to want
- *Say it:* thing, to sell, shop, cheap, expensive
- *Read it:* 这 那 吃 饭 喝 水 买 多 少 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

This? (这, *zhè.*) This one? (这个, *zhège.*) That? (那, *nà.*) Which one? (*nǎge.*) That one? (那个, *nàge.*) To eat? (吃, *chī.*) Meal? (饭, *fàn.*) Cooked rice? (*mǐfàn.*) Hungry? (*è.*) Dish of food? (*cài.*) To drink? (喝, *hē.*) Water? (水, *shuǐ.*) Thirsty? (*kě.*) Milk? (*niúnǎi.*) Tea? (*chá.*) To buy? (买, *mǎi.*) Apple? (*píngguǒ.*) Fruit? (*shuǐguǒ.*) Bread? (*miànbāo.*) Egg? (*jīdàn.*) How much? (多少, *duōshao.*) Money? (*qián.*) Yuan? (*kuài.*) Too? (*tài.*) To want? (*yào.*) Thing? (*dōngxi.*) To sell? (*mài.*) Shop? (*shāngdiàn.*) Cheap? (*piányi.*) Expensive? (*guì.*)

Chapter 43

Coming and Going

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where I am going and that I am going home.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 43: I can say where I am going and that I am going home.*

43.1 去 (qù) — to go

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cheap, then the Mandarin for expensive.

You'll want to know: 去

去 — *qù* — "to go".

我去大学 *wǒ qù dàxué* — I'm going to the university.

The new character, in pieces: 去 — a shape like 十 standing on a long bar, and under it a two-stroke piece. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

去 (*qù*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *khjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to leave'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: qù*
- *Say it: qù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù dàxué* — I'm going to the university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cheap, then the Mandarin for expensive, then say *qù* again

Before you move on

What does 去 mean? ("To go".) Say it once more.

43.2 去 — a cross on a bar, and a corner below

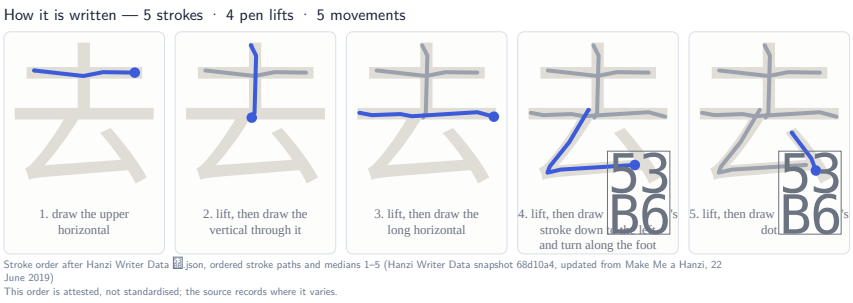
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

十 大

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shí*, *dà*

Script — a cross on a bar, and a corner below



How 去 is written, stroke by stroke

去

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, three strokes. A short horizontal, a vertical through it, then a long horizontal under them: 十 standing on a wide base.

The bottom piece, two strokes. A stroke that falls to the left and turns out to the right, then a dot inside the turn.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 去, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 去? (**Two**.) Which character you know is in the top piece? (十, on a long bar.) What is the last stroke? (**A dot**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 去, pinned stroke paths and medians.

43.3 huí — to go back; to return

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for expensive, then the Mandarin for to go.

You'll want to know: huí

huí — "to go back; to return".

wǒ huí jiā — I'm going home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huí is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to turn'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: huí*
- *Say it: huí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ huí jiā* — I'm going home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for expensive, then the Mandarin for to go, then say *huí* again

Before you move on

What does huí mean? ("To go back; to return".) Say it once more.

43.4 zǒu — to walk; to leave

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go, then the Mandarin for to go back.

You'll want to know: zǒu

zǒu — "to walk; to leave".

wǒ zǒu le — I'm off.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zǒu is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to hurry'. The sense 'to walk' is not given there, so when it arrived is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǒu*
- *Say it: zǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zǒu le* — I'm off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go, then the Mandarin for to go back, then say *zǒu* again

Before you move on

What does zǒu mean? ("To walk; to leave".) Say it once more.

43.5 chūmén — to go out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go back, then the Mandarin for to walk.

You'll want to know: chūmén

chūmén — "to go out".

māma chūmén le — Mum's gone out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūmén is built from chū 'to come forth' and mén 'door', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūmén*
- *Say it: chūmén*, once more

- *Say it: māma chūmén le* — Mum's gone out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go back, then the Mandarin for to walk, then say *chūmén* again

Before you move on

What does chūmén mean? ("To go out".) Say it once more.

43.6 xuéxiào — school

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to walk, then the Mandarin for to go out.

You'll want to know: xuéxiào

xuéxiào — "school".

wǒmen qù xuéxiào — We're off to school.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuéxiào is built from 学 'learning', inherited from Middle Chinese *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and a second character the dictionary records as *haewH*, the title of an officer. The school sense is not given there, so how it came to mean school is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuéxiào*
- *Say it: xuéxiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù xuéxiào* — We're off to school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to walk, then the Mandarin for to go out, then say *xuéxiào* again

Before you move on

What does xuéxiào mean? (“School”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 44

Places in Town

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name places in town and say how I get there.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 44: I can name places in town and say how I get there.*

44.1 车 (chē) — car; vehicle

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go out, then the Mandarin for school.

You'll want to know: 车

车 — *chē* — "car; vehicle".

> 你有车吗 *nǐ yǒu chē ma* — Have you got a car?

The new character, in pieces: 车 — four strokes: a bar, a stroke that falls and turns, a long bar, and a vertical through them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

车 (*chē*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as a cart, first made, it says, by the Yellow Emperor.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chē*
- *Say it: chē*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu chē ma* — Have you got a car?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go out, then the Mandarin for school, then say *chē* again

Before you move on

What does 车 mean? ("Car; vehicle".) Say it once more.

44.2 车 — four strokes, the vertical last

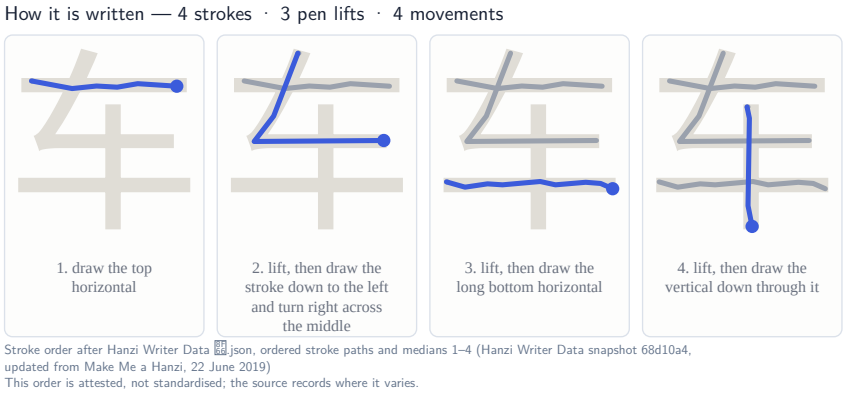
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

十 去

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shí*, *qù*

Script — four strokes, the vertical last



How 车 is written, stroke by stroke

车

One piece, four strokes.

A short horizontal at the top.

A stroke that falls to the left and turns right, along under the first bar.

A long horizontal across the bottom.

Last, the vertical, from the top bar down through everything to the foot.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 车, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 车? (**Four**.) Which stroke is last? (**The vertical**.) Which is the longest bar? (**The third stroke, along the bottom**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 车, pinned stroke paths and medians.

44.3 fàndiàn — restaurant

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for school, then the Mandarin for car.

You'll want to know: fàndiàn

fàndiàn — "restaurant".

wǒmen qù fàndiàn chī fàn — We're going out to a restaurant.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàndiàn is built from 饭 'meal' and diàn 'shop', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjonH* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàndiàn*
- *Say it: fàndiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù fàndiàn chī fàn* — We're going out to a restaurant.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for school, then the Mandarin for car, then say *fàndiàn* again

Before you move on

What does fàndiàn mean? ("Restaurant".) Say it once more.

44.4 yīyuàn — hospital

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for car, then the Mandarin for restaurant.

You'll want to know: yīyuàn

yīyuàn — "hospital".

wǒ māma qù yīyuàn le — My mum has gone to the hospital.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīyuàn is built from yī 'healing' and yuàn 'courtyard', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'i* and *hjwenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīyuàn*
- *Say it: yīyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma qù yīyuàn le* — My mum has gone to the hospital.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for car, then the Mandarin for restaurant, then say *yīyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does yīyuàn mean? ("Hospital".) Say it once more.

44.5 zuò — to sit; to travel by

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for restaurant, then the Mandarin for hospital.

You'll want to know: zuò

zuò — "to sit; to travel by".

wǒmen zuò chē qù — We're going by car.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuò is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as bending the joints. Its use for travelling by car or bus is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuò*
- *Say it: zuò*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò chē qù* — We're going by car.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for restaurant, then the Mandarin for hospital, then say *zuò* again

Before you move on

What does zuò mean? ("To sit; to travel by".) Say it once more.

44.6 chūzūchē — taxi

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hospital, then the Mandarin for to sit.

You'll want to know: chūzūchē

chūzūchē — "taxi".

chūzūchē hěn guì — Taxis are expensive.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūzūchē is built from chūzū 'to rent out' and 车 'car'; its parts are inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhwit*, *tsu* 'tax' and *tsyhae*

(Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūzūchē*
- *Say it: chūzūchē*, once more
- *Say it: chūzūchē hěn guì* — Taxis are expensive.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hospital, then the Mandarin for to sit, then say *chūzūchē* again

Before you move on

What does chūzūchē mean? ("Taxi".) Say it once more.

Chapter 45

Today and Tomorrow

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say today, yesterday, tomorrow and now.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 45: I can say today, yesterday, tomorrow and now.*

45.1 天 (tiān) — day; sky

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sit, then the Mandarin for taxi.

You'll want to know: 天

天 — *tiān* — "day; sky".

> 那天我们去大学了 *nà tiān wǒmen qù dàxué le* — That day we went to the university.

The new character, in pieces: 天 — 一 above 大: one more bar over the big piece. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

天 (*tiān*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the highest, with nothing above it', the sky. Its use for a day is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiān*
- *Say it: tiān*, once more
- *Say it: nà tiān wǒmen qù dàxué le* — That day we went to the university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sit, then the Mandarin for taxi, then say *tiān* again

Before you move on

What does 天 mean? ("Day; sky".) Say it once more.

45.2 天 — one more bar over 大

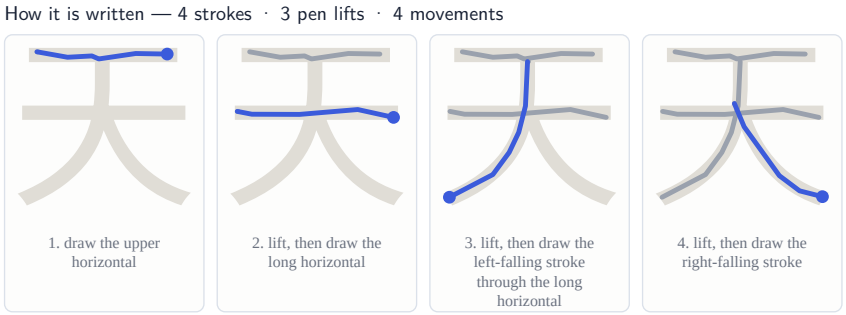
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

一 大

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yī*, *dà*

Script — one more bar over 大



How 天 is written, stroke by stroke

天

Two pieces your hand knows, top to bottom: 一, then 大.
一, one stroke, a short horizontal at the top.
大, three strokes: a longer horizontal, a left-falling stroke from above it, and a right-falling stroke.
1 + 3 = four. Keep the top bar shorter than the one under it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 天, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which two characters you know make 天? (**一 and 大.**) Which bar is longer? (**The lower one.**) How many strokes? (**Four.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 天, pinned stroke paths and medians.

45.3 今天 (jīntiān) — today

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for taxi, then the Mandarin for day.

You'll want to know: 今天

今天 — *jīntiān* — "today".

你们今天去吗 *nǐmen jīntiān qù ma* — Are you going today?

The new character, in pieces: 今 — 人 as a roof, a dot under it, and a stroke that runs across and turns down. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

今天 (*jīntiān*) is built from 今 'now' and 天 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kim* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses *kim* as the opposite of olden times.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīntiān*
- *Say it: jīntiān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐmen jīntiān qù ma* — Are you going today?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for taxi, then the Mandarin for day, then say *jīntiān* again

Before you move on

What does 今天 mean? ("Today".) Say it once more.

45.4 今 — a roof, a dot and a turn

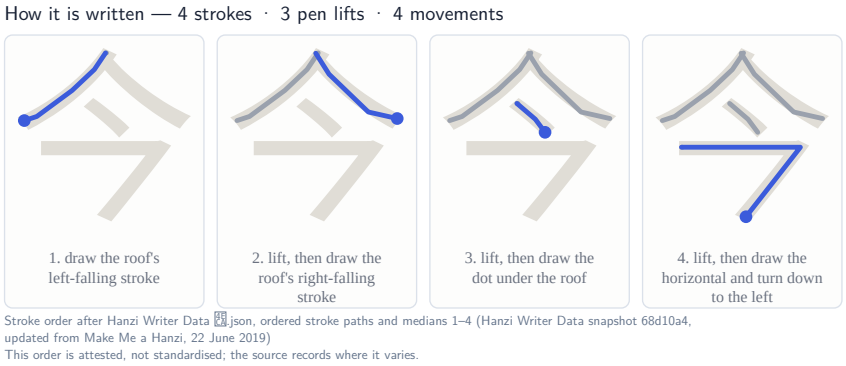
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jīntiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

人 个

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *gè*

Script — a roof, a dot and a turn



How 今 is written, stroke by stroke

今

Top to bottom.

The roof, 人, two strokes, spread wide: a left-falling stroke, then a right-falling stroke, as in 个.

A dot in the middle, under the roof.

A stroke that runs across and turns down to the left, under the dot.

2 + 1 + 1 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 今, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which character you know is the roof of 今? (人.) Which other character has the same roof? (个.) What comes right after the roof? (**A dot**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 今, pinned stroke paths and medians.

45.5 zuótiān — yesterday

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for day, then the Mandarin for today.

You'll want to know: zuótiān

zuótiān — "yesterday".

zuótiān wǒ hěn lèi — I was really tired yesterday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuótiān is built from zuó 'the day before' and 天 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzak* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses *dzak* as the day one night back.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuótiān*
- *Say it: zuótiān*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān wǒ hěn lèi* — I was really tired yesterday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for day, then the Mandarin for today, then say *zuótiān* again

Before you move on

What does zuótiān mean? ("Yesterday".) Say it once more.

45.6 xiànzài — now

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for today, then the Mandarin for yesterday.

You'll want to know: xiànzài

xiànzài — "now".

> *nǐ xiànzài máng ma* — Are you busy right now?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiànzài is built from xiàn 'to appear' and zài 'to be present', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *henH* and *dzojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiànzài*
- *Say it: xiànzài*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xiànzài máng ma* — Are you busy right now?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for today, then the Mandarin for yesterday, then say *xiànzài* again

Before you move on

What does xiànzài mean? ("Now".) Say it once more.

45.7 míngtiān — tomorrow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for yesterday, then the Mandarin for now.

You'll want to know: míngtiān

míngtiān — "tomorrow".

wǒ jīntiān hěn máng, míngtiān bù máng — I'm busy today, but not tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

míngtiān is built from míng 'bright' and 天 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjaeng* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngtiān*
- *Say it: míngtiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jīntiān hěn máng, míngtiān bù máng* — I'm busy today, but not tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for yesterday, then the Mandarin for now, then say *míngtiān* again

Before you move on

What does míngtiān mean? ("Tomorrow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 46

The Week

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the week, Monday, Sunday and the weekend.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 46: I can name the week, Monday, Sunday and the weekend.*

46.1 星期 (xīngqī) — week

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for now, then the Mandarin for tomorrow.

You'll want to know: 星期

星期 — *xīngqī* — "week".

> 一个星期有七天 *yí ge xīngqī yǒu qī tiān* — There are seven days in a week.

The new character, in pieces: 星 — 日 above 生; 期 — an eight-stroke piece on the left and a moon piece on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

星期 (*xīngqī*) is built from 星 'star' and 期 'appointed time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *seng* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription). How the pair came to mean a week is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīngqī*
- *Say it: xīngqī*, once more
- *Say it: yí ge xīngqī yǒu qī tiān* — There are seven days in a week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for now, then the Mandarin for tomorrow, then say *xīngqī* again

Before you move on

What does 星期 mean? ("Week".) Say it once more.

46.2 星 — 日 above 生

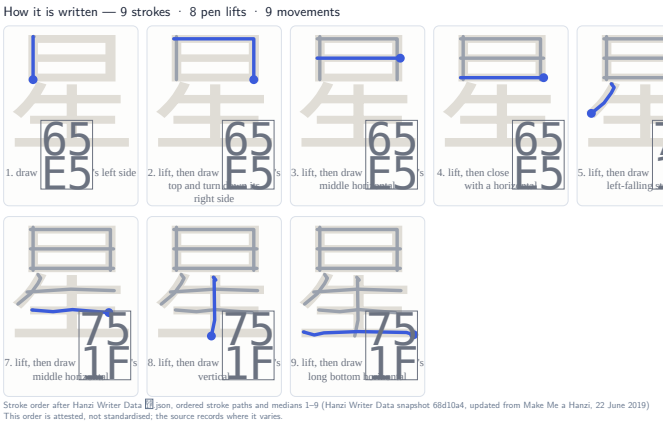
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xīngqī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

日 生

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *shēng*

Script — 日 above 生



How 星 is written, stroke by stroke

星

Two pieces you know, top to bottom: 日, then 生.

日, four strokes, short and wide on top.

生, five strokes, as in 学生: a left-falling stroke, a horizontal, a shorter horizontal, the vertical through them, and the long bar at the foot.

4 + 5 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 星, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which two characters you know make 星? (**日 and 生**.) Which is on top? (日.) Which stroke of 生 is last? (**The long bar at the foot**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 星, pinned stroke paths and medians.

46.3 期 — eight strokes, then the moon

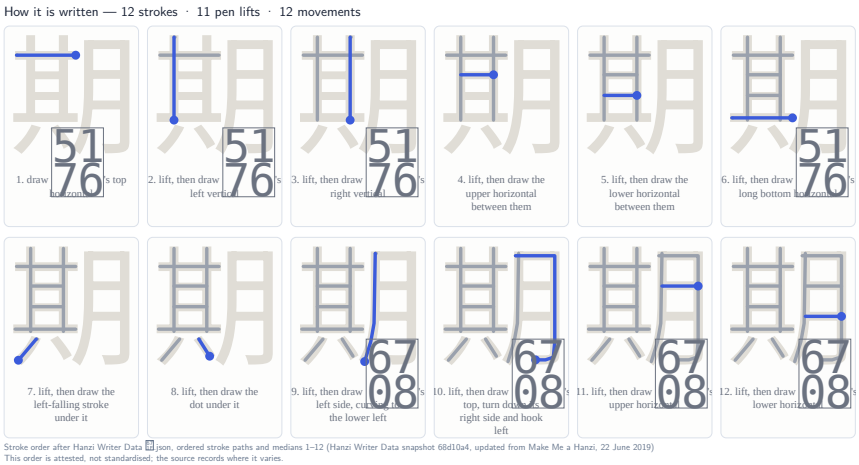
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xīngqī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  有 日

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yǒu*, *rì*

Script — eight strokes, then the moon



How 期 *is written, stroke by stroke*

期

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, eight strokes. A horizontal at the top. Two verticals down through it. Two short horizontals between them. A long horizontal across the foot. Then a left-falling stroke and a dot under it.

The moon, four strokes. A left-falling stroke down the left. A horizontal that turns down the right and hooks. Two short horizontals inside. It is the lower part of 有.

8 + 4 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 期, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 期? (**Two** — eight strokes, then the moon.) What is under the long bar of the left piece? (**A left-falling stroke and a dot**.) How does the moon begin? (**With a left-falling stroke**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 期, pinned stroke paths and medians.

46.4 星期一 (xīngqīyī) — Monday

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tomorrow, then the Mandarin for week.

You'll want to know: 星期一

星期一 — *xīngqīyī* — "Monday".

今天星期一 *jīntiān xīngqīyī* — Today's Monday.

Tone: 一 keeps its first tone here, *yī*. It counts a day in order, and the change you know from *yìbǎi* does not apply.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

星期一 (*xīngqīyī*) is built from 星期 'week' and 一 'one': day one of the week.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīngqīyī*
- *Say it: xīngqīyī*, once more

- *Say it: jīntiān xīngqīyī* — Today's Monday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tomorrow, then the Mandarin for week, then say *xīngqīyī* again

Before you move on

What does 星期一 mean? ("Monday".) Say it once more.

46.5 shíhou — time; moment

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for week, then the Mandarin for Monday.

You'll want to know: shíhou

shíhou — "time; moment".

nǐ shénme shíhou qù — When are you going?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shíhou is built from shí 'time' and hou 'to wait for', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyi* and *huwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: shíhou*
- *Say it: shíhou*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shénme shíhou qù* — When are you going?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for week, then the Mandarin for Monday, then say *shíhou* again

Before you move on

What does shíhou mean? ("Time; moment".) Say it once more.

46.6 zhōumò — weekend

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for Monday, then the Mandarin for moment.

You'll want to know: zhōumò

zhōumò — "weekend".

zhōumò wǒ xǐhuan kàn shū — At the weekend I like to read.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhōumò is built from zhōu 'week' and mò 'end'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *mat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the tip of a tree' and 'end'. The first character is recorded there as *tsyuw*, 'a full circuit'; the sense week is not given, so how it came to name the week is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōumò*
- *Say it: zhōumò*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒ xǐhuan kàn shū* — At the weekend I like to read.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for Monday, then the Mandarin for moment, then say *zhōumò* again

Before you move on

What does zhōumò mean? ("Weekend".) Say it once more.

46.7 星期天 (xīngqītiān) — Sunday

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for moment, then the Mandarin for weekend.

You'll want to know: 星期天

星期天 — *xīngqītiān* — "Sunday".

我喜欢星期天 *wǒ xǐhuan xīngqītiān* — Sunday is the day I like best.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

星期天 (*xīngqītiān*) is built from 星期 'week' and 天 'day'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīngqītiān*
- *Say it: xīngqītiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan xīngqītiān* — Sunday is the day I like best.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for moment, then the Mandarin for weekend, then say *xīngqītiān* again

Before you move on

What does 星期天 mean? ("Sunday".) Say it once more.

Chapter 47

Months and Years

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say this year, next year, the month and the date.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 47: I can say this year, next year, the month and the date.*

47.1 年 (nián) — year

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for weekend, then the Mandarin for Sunday.

You'll want to know: 年

年 — *nián* — "year".

> 一年有多少个星期 *yì nián yǒu duōshao ge xīngqī* — How many weeks are there in a year?

The new character, in pieces: 年 — six strokes: a short fall, two bars, a short vertical on the left, a long bar, and one long vertical through them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

年 (*nián*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the grain is ripe'. One harvest a year

is the usual explanation of the sense, though the step is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: nián*
- *Say it: nián*, once more
- *Say it: yì nián yǒu duōshao ge xīngqī* — How many weeks are there in a year?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for weekend, then the Mandarin for Sunday, then say *nián* again

Before you move on

What does 年 mean? ("Year".) Say it once more.

47.2 年 — three bars and a long vertical

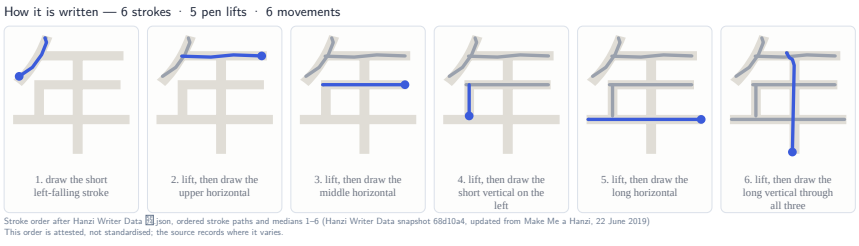
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *nián* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  生 十

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shēng*, *shí*

Script — three bars and a long vertical



How 年 is written, stroke by stroke

年

One piece, six strokes.
A short left-falling stroke at the top left.
Two horizontals, the upper one short, the one below it longer.
A short vertical down from the left end of the second bar.
A long horizontal across the bottom.
Last, the long vertical down through the middle, past the bottom bar.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 年, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 年? (**Six.**) What comes first? (**A short left-falling stroke.**) Which stroke is last? (**The long vertical through the middle.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 年, pinned stroke paths and medians.

47.3 yuè — month; moon

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for Sunday, then the Mandarin for year.

You'll want to know: yuè

yuè — "month; moon".

zhège yuè wǒ hěn máng — I'm busy this month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuè is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngjwot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where the dictionary quotes an old saying that the moon is the essence of water.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuè*
- *Say it: yuè*, once more
- *Say it: zhège yuè wǒ hěn máng* — I'm busy this month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for Sunday, then the Mandarin for year, then say *yuè* again

Before you move on

What does yuè mean? ("Month; moon".) Say it once more.

47.4 明年 (míngnián) — next year

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for year, then the Mandarin for month.

You'll want to know: 明年

明年 — *míngnián* — "next year".

明年我买车 *míngnián wǒ mǎi chē* — I'm buying a car next year.

The new character, in pieces: 明 — 日 on the left and, on the right, the moon piece, the word yuè from the lesson before. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

明年 (*míngnián*) is built from 明 'bright' and 年 'year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjaeng* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses *mjaeng* 'light'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngnián*
- *Say it: míngnián*, once more
- *Say it: míngnián wǒ mǎi chē* — I'm buying a car next year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for year, then the Mandarin for month, then say *míngnián* again

Before you move on

What does 明年 mean? ("Next year".) Say it once more.

47.5 明 — the sun beside the moon

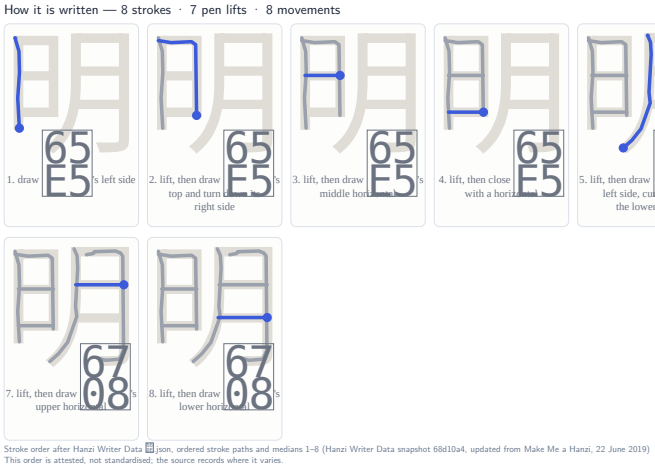
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *míngnián* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 期

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *qī*

Script — the sun beside the moon



How 明 *is written, stroke by stroke*

明

Two pieces, left before right: the sun, then the moon.
日**, four strokes**, narrow and set a little high on the left.
The moon, four strokes, as on the right of 期: a left-falling stroke, a horizontal that turns down and hooks, and two short horizontals inside.
4 + 4 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 明, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which two pieces make 明? (日 **and the moon.**) Which character from the last chapters has the same moon on the right? (期.) How many strokes? (**Eight.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 明, pinned stroke paths and medians.

47.6 今年 (jīnnián) — this year

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for month, then the Mandarin for next year.

You'll want to know: 今年

今年 — *jīnnián* — "this year".

我今年十八岁 *wǒ jīnnián shíbā suì* — I'm eighteen this year.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

今年 (*jīnnián*) is built from 今 'now' and 年 'year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kim* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīnnián*
- *Say it: jīnnián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jīnnián shíbā suì* — I'm eighteen this year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for month, then the Mandarin for next year, then say *jīnnián* again

Before you move on

What does 今年 mean? ("This year".) Say it once more.

47.7 日期 (rìqī) — date

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for next year, then the Mandarin for this year.

You'll want to know: 日期

日期 — *rìqī* — "date".

请看日期 *qǐng kàn rìqī* — Please check the date.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

日期 (*rìqī*) is built from 日 'day' and 期 'appointed time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyit* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: rìqī*
- *Say it: rìqī*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng kàn rìqī* — Please check the date.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for next year, then the Mandarin for this year, then say *rìqī* again

Before you move on

What does 日期 mean? ("Date".) Say it once more.

47.8 Looking back: from Coming and Going to Months and Years

Say the Mandarin for to go and to go back.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to go, to go back, to walk, to go out, school
- *Say it:* car, restaurant, hospital, to sit, taxi
- *Say it:* day, today, yesterday, now, tomorrow

- *Say it:* week, Monday, moment, weekend, Sunday
- *Say it:* year, month, next year, this year, date
- *Read it:* 去 车 天 今 星 期 年 明 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To go? (去, *qù.*) To go back? (*huí.*) To walk? (*zǒu.*) To go out? (*chūmén.*) School? (*xuéxiào.*) Car? (车, *chē.*) Restaurant? (*fàndiàn.*) Hospital? (*yīyuàn.*) To sit? (*zuò.*) Taxi? (*chūzūchē.*) Day? (天, *tiān.*) Today? (今天, *jīntiān.*) Yesterday? (*zuótiān.*) Now? (*xiànzài.*) Tomorrow? (*míngtiān.*) Week? (星期, *xīngqī.*) Monday? (星期一, *xīngqīyī.*) Moment? (*shíhou.*) Weekend? (*zhōumò.*) Sunday? (星期天, *xīngqītiān.*) Year? (年, *nián.*) Month? (*yuè.*) Next year? (明年, *míngnián.*) This year? (今年, *jīnnián.*) Date? (日期, *rìqī.*)

Chapter 48

Telling the Time

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask the time and say it to the half hour and the minute.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 48: I can ask the time and say it to the half hour and the minute.*

48.1 点 (diǎn) — o'clock; dot

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for this year, then the Mandarin for date.

You'll want to know: 点

点 — *diǎn* — "o'clock; dot".

> 我们明天八点去 *wǒmen míngtiān bā diǎn qù* — We're going at eight tomorrow.

The new character, in pieces: 点 — a small vertical and bar on top of 口, standing over four dots. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

点 (*diǎn*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a dot made with the brush'. Its use for the hours is not given there, so how it took that job is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: diǎn*
- *Say it: diǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen míngtiān bā diǎn qù* — We're going at eight tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for this year, then the Mandarin for date, then say *diǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 点 mean? ("O'clock; dot".) Say it once more.

48.2 点 — a mark on 口, over four dots

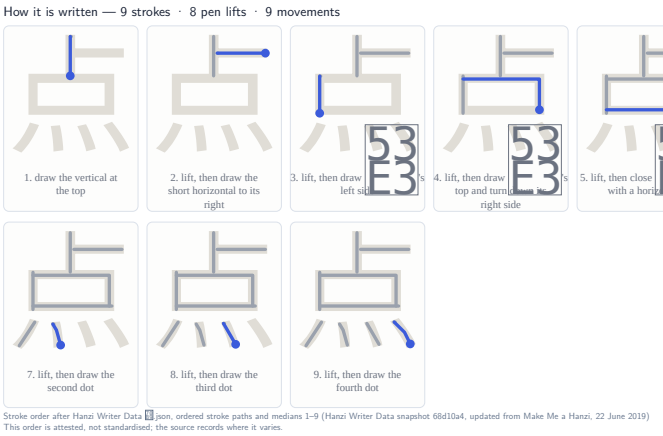
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *diǎn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 明

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *míng*

Script — a mark on 口, over four dots



How 点 is written, stroke by stroke

点

Three pieces, top to bottom.

Two strokes on top. A short vertical, then a short horizontal from its middle out to the right.

口, three strokes, wide, under them.

Four dots along the bottom, left to right; the first leans left, the other three lean right.

2 + 3 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 点, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 点? (**Three**.) Which character you know is in the middle? (口.) How many dots at the bottom? (**Four**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 点, pinned stroke paths and medians.

48.3 fēn — minute; to divide

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for date, then the Mandarin for o'clock.

You'll want to know: fēn

fēn — "minute; to divide".

bā diǎn shí fēn — Ten past eight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēn is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to divide'. Its use for minutes is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēn*
- *Say it: fēn*, once more
- *Say it: bā diǎn shí fēn* — Ten past eight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for date, then the Mandarin for o'clock, then say *fēn* again

Before you move on

What does fēn mean? ("Minute; to divide".) Say it once more.

48.4 bàn — half

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for o'clock, then the Mandarin for minute.

You'll want to know: bàn

bàn — "half".

bā diǎn bàn — Half past eight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *panH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a thing divided in the middle'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàn*
- *Say it: bàn*, once more
- *Say it: bā diǎn bàn* — Half past eight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for o'clock, then the Mandarin for minute, then say *bàn* again

Before you move on

What does bàn mean? ("Half".) Say it once more.

48.5 jǐ — how many; a few

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for minute, then the Mandarin for half.

You'll want to know: jǐ

jǐ — "how many; a few".

xiànzài jǐ diǎn — What time is it?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
jǐ asks for a small number, as in *jǐ diǎn*; *duōshao* asks for any amount.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǐ is inherited from Middle Chinese *kj+jX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'how many'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐ*
- *Say it: jǐ*, once more
- *Say it: xiànzài jǐ diǎn* — What time is it?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for minute, then the Mandarin for half, then say *jǐ* again

Before you move on

What does jǐ mean? ("How many; a few".) Say it once more.

48.6 děng — to wait; to wait for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for half, then the Mandarin for how many.

You'll want to know: děng

děng — "to wait; to wait for".

wǒ děng nǐ — I'll wait for you.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

děng is inherited from Middle Chinese *tongX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'equal, of a kind'. The sense 'to wait' is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: děng*
- *Say it: děng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ děng nǐ* — I'll wait for you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for half, then the Mandarin for how many, then say *děng* again

Before you move on

What does děng mean? ("To wait; to wait for".) Say it once more.

Chapter 49

A Day from Morning to Night

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the parts of the day and greet somebody in the evening.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 49: I can name the parts of the day and greet somebody in the evening.*

49.1 上午 (shàngwǔ) — morning (before noon)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how many, then the Mandarin for to wait.

You'll want to know: 上午

上午 — *shàngwǔ* — "morning (before noon)".

> 上午十点我去大学 *shàngwǔ shí diǎn wǒ qù dàxué* — At ten in the morning I go to the university.

The new character, in pieces: 午 — the top of 年: a short fall, two bars and a vertical. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上午 (*shàngwǔ*) is built from 上 'upper, earlier' and 午 'noon', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangH* and *nguX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary gives *nguX* as the name of one of the branches of the old calendar.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngwǔ*
- *Say it: shàngwǔ*, once more
- *Say it: shàngwǔ shí diǎn wǒ qù dàxué* — At ten in the morning I go to the university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how many, then the Mandarin for to wait, then say *shàngwǔ* again

Before you move on

What does 上午 mean? ("Morning (before noon)".) Say it once more.

49.2 午 — the top of 年

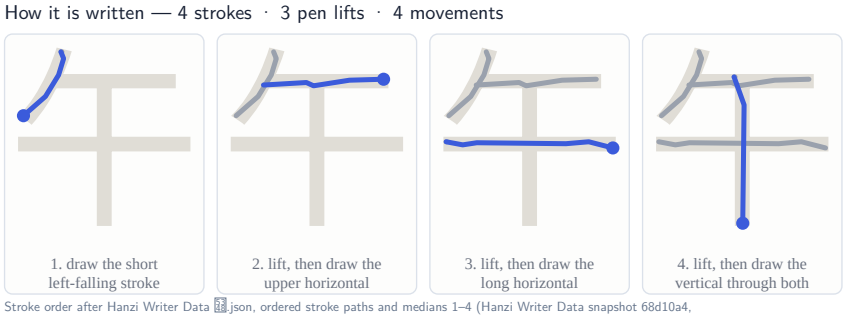
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shàngwǔ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  年 十

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nián*, *shí*

Script — the top of 午



How 午 is written, stroke by stroke

午

One piece, four strokes.
A short left-falling stroke at the top left.
A shorter horizontal, then **a long horizontal** under it.
Last, the vertical down through the middle of both bars.
It is 年 with its short vertical and bottom bar left out.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 午, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which character you know begins like 午? (年.) How many strokes? (**Four**.) Which bar is longer? (**The lower one**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 午, pinned stroke paths and medians.

49.3 中午 (zhōngwǔ) — noon

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wait, then the Mandarin for before noon.

You'll want to know: 中午

中午 — *zhōngwǔ* — "noon".

中午我们吃饭 *zhōngwǔ wǒmen chī fàn* — We have lunch at noon.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中午 (*zhōngwǔ*) is built from 中 'middle' and 午 'noon', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *nguX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōngwǔ*
- *Say it: zhōngwǔ*, once more
- *Say it: zhōngwǔ wǒmen chī fàn* — We have lunch at noon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wait, then the Mandarin for before noon, then say *zhōngwǔ* again

Before you move on

What does 中午 mean? ("Noon".) Say it once more.

49.4 晚上 (wǎnshang) — evening

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for before noon, then the Mandarin for noon.

You'll want to know: 晚上

晚上 — *wǎnshang* — "evening".

晚上我看书 *wǎnshang wǒ kàn shū* — I read in the evenings.

The new character, in pieces: 晚 — 日 on the left and a seven-stroke piece on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

晚上 (*wǎnshang*) is built from 晚 'dusk' and the light ending shang, as in 早上. 晚 is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'dusk'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎnshang*
- *Say it: wǎnshang*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang wǒ kàn shū* — I read in the evenings.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for before noon, then the Mandarin for noon, then say *wǎnshang* again

Before you move on

What does 晚上 mean? ("Evening".) Say it once more.

49.5 晚 — 日, then seven strokes

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wǎnshang* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 多

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *duō*

Script — 日, then seven strokes

How 晚 *is written, stroke by stroke*

晚

Two pieces, left before right.
日, **four strokes**, narrow on the left.

The right piece, seven strokes. A short left-falling stroke and a short stroke that runs across and falls, like the top of 多. A vertical, a horizontal that turns down, and a horizontal under it to close a small box. Then a left-falling stroke, and a vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up.

4 + 7 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 晚, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 晚? (**Two** — 日, then seven strokes.) Which character you know starts the right piece the same way? (多.) How

does the last stroke end? (**It hooks up**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 晚, pinned stroke paths and medians.

49.6 xiàwǔ — afternoon

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for noon, then the Mandarin for evening.

You'll want to know: xiàwǔ

xiàwǔ — "afternoon".

xiàwǔ wǒ hěn máng — I'm busy in the afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàwǔ is built from xià 'lower, after' and 午 'noon', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *nguX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàwǔ*
- *Say it: xiàwǔ*, once more
- *Say it: xiàwǔ wǒ hěn máng* — I'm busy in the afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for noon, then the Mandarin for evening, then say *xiàwǔ* again

Before you move on

What does xiàwǔ mean? ("Afternoon".) Say it once more.

49.7 晚上好 (wǎnshang hǎo) — good evening

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for evening, then the Mandarin for afternoon.

You'll want to know: 晚上好

晚上好 — *wǎnshang hǎo* — "good evening".

大家晚上好 *dàjiā wǎnshang hǎo* — Good evening, everyone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

晚上好 (*wǎnshang hǎo*) is built from 晚上 'evening' and 好 'good', the same shape as 早上好.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎnshang hǎo*
- *Say it: wǎnshang hǎo*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā wǎnshang hǎo* — Good evening, everyone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for evening, then the Mandarin for afternoon, then say *wǎnshang hǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 晚上好 mean? ("Good evening".) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Sleeping and Waking

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say when I sleep, get up and rest, and ask about health.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 50: I can say when I sleep, get up and rest, and ask about health.*

50.1 shuìjiào — to sleep; to go to bed

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for afternoon, then the Mandarin for good evening.

You'll want to know: shuìjiào

shuìjiào — "to sleep; to go to bed".

> *wǒ qù shuìjiào* — I'm off to bed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuìjiào is built from shuì 'to sleep' and jiào 'sleep', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyweH* and *kaewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second with this very pair.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuìjiào*
- *Say it: shuìjiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù shuìjiào* — I'm off to bed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for afternoon, then the Mandarin for good evening, then say *shuìjiào* again

Before you move on

What does shuìjiào mean? ("To sleep; to go to bed".) Say it once more.

50.2 qǐchuáng — to get up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for good evening, then the Mandarin for to sleep.

You'll want to know: qǐchuáng

qǐchuáng — "to get up".

wǒ qī diǎn qǐchuáng — I get up at seven.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qǐchuáng is built from qǐ 'to rise' and chuáng 'bed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khiX* and *dzrjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐchuáng*
- *Say it: qǐchuáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qī diǎn qǐchuáng* — I get up at seven.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for good evening, then the Mandarin for to sleep, then say *qǐchuáng* again

Before you move on

What does qǐchuáng mean? ("To get up".) Say it once more.

50.3 xiūxi — to rest

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sleep, then the Mandarin for to get up.

You'll want to know: xiūxi

xiūxi — "to rest".

xīngqītiān wǒ xiūxi — On Sunday I take it easy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiūxi is built from xiū 'to rest' and xi 'to stop, to breathe', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjuw* and *sik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiūxi*
- *Say it: xiūxi*, once more

- *Say it: xīngqītiān wǒ xiūxi* — On Sunday I take it easy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sleep, then the Mandarin for to get up, then say *xiūxi* again

Before you move on

What does xiūxi mean? ("To rest".) Say it once more.

50.4 shēntǐ — body; health

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get up, then the Mandarin for to rest.

You'll want to know: shēntǐ

shēntǐ — "body; health".

nǐ shēntǐ hǎo ma — How's your health?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēntǐ is built from shēn 'body, self' and tǐ 'body', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syin* and *thejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēntǐ*
- *Say it: shēntǐ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shēntǐ hǎo ma* — How's your health?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get up, then the Mandarin for to rest, then say *shēntǐ* again

Before you move on

What does shēntǐ mean? (“Body; health”.) Say it once more.

50.5 bìng — to fall ill; illness

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to rest, then the Mandarin for health.

You’ll want to know: bìng

bìng — “to fall ill; illness”.

wǒ māma bìng le — My mum is ill.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bìng is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’worry, pain’ and ’an illness grown worse’.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìng*
- *Say it: bìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma bìng le* — My mum is ill.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to rest, then the Mandarin for health, then say *bìng* again

Before you move on

What does bìng mean? (“To fall ill; illness”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

How You Feel

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am happy, afraid, cold or hot.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 51: I can say I am happy, afraid, cold or hot.*

51.1 gāoxìng — happy; glad

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for health, then the Mandarin for to fall ill.

You'll want to know: gāoxìng

gāoxìng — "happy; glad".

> *wǒ hěn gāoxìng* — I'm so pleased.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gāoxìng is built from gāo 'high' and xìng 'mood', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *xingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'high'; it gives the second reading no gloss of its own, so 'mood' is the usual explanation, not a settled one.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāoxìng*
- *Say it: gāoxìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn gāoxìng* — I'm so pleased.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for health, then the Mandarin for to fall ill, then say *gāoxìng* again

Before you move on

What does gāoxìng mean? ("Happy; glad".) Say it once more.

51.2 pà — to be afraid of; to fear

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fall ill, then the Mandarin for happy.

You'll want to know: pà

pà — "to be afraid of; to fear".

nǐ pà shénme — What are you afraid of?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pà is inherited from Middle Chinese *phaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to fear'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: pà*
- *Say it: pà*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ pà shénme* — What are you afraid of?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fall ill, then the Mandarin for happy, then say *pà* again

Before you move on

What does pà mean? ("To be afraid of; to fear".) Say it once more.

51.3 lěng — cold

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for happy, then the Mandarin for to be afraid.

You'll want to know: lěng

lěng — "cold".

jīntiān hěn lěng — It's cold today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lěng is inherited from Middle Chinese *lengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'cold'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: lěng*
- *Say it: lěng*, once more

- *Say it: jīntiān hěn lěng* — It's cold today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for happy, then the Mandarin for to be afraid, then say *lěng* again

Before you move on

What does lěng mean? ("Cold".) Say it once more.

51.4 rè — hot

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be afraid, then the Mandarin for cold.

You'll want to know: rè

rè — "hot".

zhōngwǔ hěn rè — It's hot at midday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rè is inherited from Middle Chinese *nyet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as burning, as if by fire.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: rè*
- *Say it: rè*, once more
- *Say it: zhōngwǔ hěn rè* — It's hot at midday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be afraid, then the Mandarin for cold, then say *rè* again

Before you move on

What does rè mean? (“Hot”.) Say it once more.

51.5 kū — to cry; to weep

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cold, then the Mandarin for hot.

You’ll want to know: kū

kū — “to cry; to weep”.

háizi kū le — The child started crying.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kū is inherited from Middle Chinese *khuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’a sound of grief’.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: kū*
- *Say it: kū*, once more
- *Say it: háizi kū le* — The child started crying.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cold, then the Mandarin for hot, then say *kū* again

Before you move on

What does kū mean? (“To cry; to weep”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

Head, Hands and Feet

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my head, hands, feet, eyes and ears.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 52: I can name my head, hands, feet, eyes and ears.*

52.1 手 (shǒu) — hand

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hot, then the Mandarin for to cry.

You'll want to know: 手

手 — *shǒu* — "hand".

> 我的手很小 *wǒ de shǒu hěn xiǎo* — My hands are small.

The new character, in pieces: 手 — a short fall, two bars, and a vertical that hooks at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

手 (*shǒu*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed with the pair 'hand and foot'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒu*
- *Say it: shǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shǒu hěn xiǎo* — My hands are small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hot, then the Mandarin for to cry, then say *shǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 手 mean? ("Hand".) Say it once more.

52.2 手 — a fall, two bars, a hook

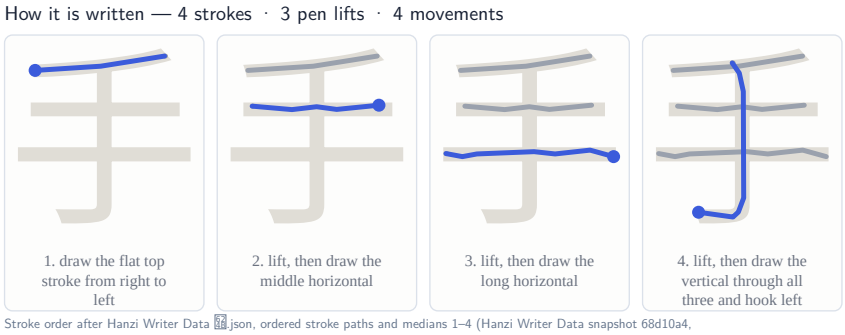
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  看 小

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kàn*, *xiǎo*

Script — a fall, two bars, a hook



How 手 is written, stroke by stroke

手

One piece, four strokes, top to bottom.
A short left-falling stroke across the top, from right to left.
Two horizontals, the lower one longer.
Last, a vertical down through both bars, hooking to the left at the foot.

The top of 看 is this hand, squeezed flat over the eye.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 手, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 手? (**Four**.) Which way does the first stroke fall? (**To the left**.) Which character you know has a hand on top? (看.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 手, pinned stroke paths and medians.

52.3 tóu — head

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to cry, then the Mandarin for hand.

You'll want to know: tóu

tóu — "head".

tā de tóu hěn dà — He's got a big head.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóu is inherited from Middle Chinese *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'head'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóu*
- *Say it: tóu*, once more
- *Say it: tā de tóu hěn dà* — He's got a big head.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to cry, then the Mandarin for hand, then say *tóu* again

Before you move on

What does tóu mean? ("Head".) Say it once more.

52.4 jiǎo — foot

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hand, then the Mandarin for head.

You'll want to know: jiǎo

jiǎo — "foot".

wǒ de jiǎo hěn lěng — My feet are cold.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as the part that tucks back when you sit; whether that meant the leg or the foot is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎo*
- *Say it: jiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de jiǎo hěn lěng* — My feet are cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hand, then the Mandarin for head, then say *jiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎo mean? ("Foot".) Say it once more.

52.5 yǎnjing — eye

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for head, then the Mandarin for foot.

You'll want to know: yǎnjing

yǎnjing — "eye".

tā de yǎnjing hěn hǎokàn — She has lovely eyes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎnjing is built from yǎn 'eye' and jing 'eyeball', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngeanX* and *tsjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnjing*
- *Say it: yǎnjing*, once more
- *Say it: tā de yǎnjing hěn hǎokàn* — She has lovely eyes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for head, then the Mandarin for foot, then say *yǎnjing* again

Before you move on

What does yǎnjing mean? ("Eye".) Say it once more.

52.6 ěrduo — ear

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for foot, then the Mandarin for eye.

You'll want to know: ěrduo

ěrduo — "ear".

háizi de ěrduo hěn xiǎo — The child's ears are tiny.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ěrduo is built from ěr 'ear' and duo, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyiX* and *twaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as what hears and the second as something hanging from a tree; the second probably names the soft lobe that hangs, though that is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: ěrduo*
- *Say it: ěrduo*, once more
- *Say it: háizi de ěrduo hěn xiǎo* — The child's ears are tiny.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for foot, then the Mandarin for eye, then say *ěrduo* again

Before you move on

What does ěrduo mean? ("Ear".) Say it once more.

52.7 Looking back: from Telling the Time to Head, Hands and Feet

Say the Mandarin for o'clock and minute.

Your turn

- *Say it:* o'clock, minute, half, how many, to wait
- *Say it:* before noon, noon, evening, afternoon, good evening
- *Say it:* to sleep, to get up, to rest, health, to fall ill
- *Say it:* happy, to be afraid, cold, hot, to cry
- *Say it:* hand, head, foot, eye, ear

- *Read it:* 点 午 晚 手 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

O'clock? (点, *diǎn.*) Minute? (*fēn.*) Half? (*bàn.*) How many? (*jǐ.*) To wait? (*děng.*) Before noon? (上午, *shàngwǔ.*) Noon? (中午, *zhōngwǔ.*) Evening? (晚上, *wǎnshang.*) Afternoon? (*xiàwǔ.*) Good evening? (晚上好, *wǎnshang hǎo.*) To sleep? (*shuìjiào.*) To get up? (*qǐchuáng.*) To rest? (*xiūxi.*) Health? (*shēntǐ.*) To fall ill? (*bìng.*) Happy? (*gāoxìng.*) To be afraid? (*pà.*) Cold? (*lěng.*) Hot? (*rè.*) To cry? (*kū.*) Hand? (手, *shǒu.*) Head? (*tóu.*) Foot? (*jiǎo.*) Eye? (*yǎnjing.*) Ear? (*ěrduo.*)

Chapter 53

Speaking and Hearing

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that I understand or not, and ask somebody to speak slowly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 53: I can say that I understand or not, and ask somebody to speak slowly.*

53.1 说 (shuō) — to say; to speak

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for eye, then the Mandarin for ear.

You'll want to know: 说

说 — *shuō* — "to say; to speak".

> 他说你的手很好看 *tā shuō nǐ de shǒu hěn hǎokàn* — He says you have lovely hands.

The new character, in pieces: 说 — 讠 , the speech piece, on the left; on the right a dot and a short fall, then 口, then two legs. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

说 (*shuō*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *sywet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to tell'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuō*
- *Say it: shuō*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō nǐ de shǒu hěn hǎokàn* — He says you have lovely hands.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for eye, then the Mandarin for ear, then say *shuō* again

Before you move on

What does 说 mean? ("To say; to speak".) Say it once more.

53.2 说 — the speech piece, then a mouth with legs

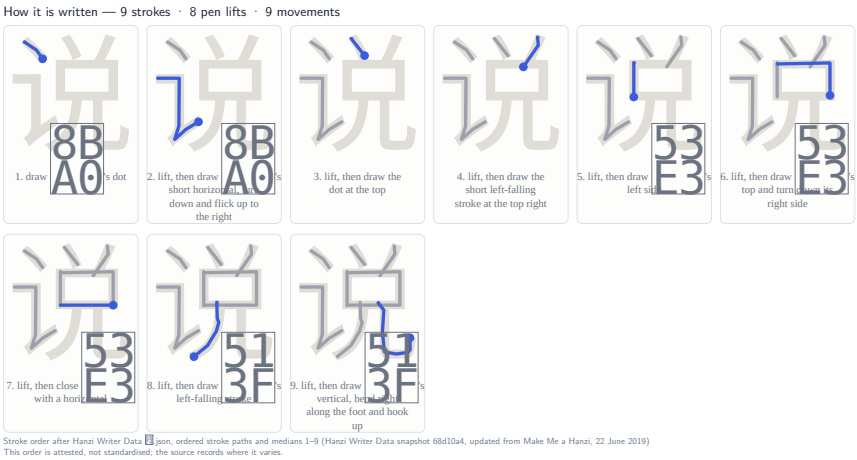
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shuō* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

讠 请

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — the speech piece, *qǐng*

Script — the speech piece, then a mouth with legs



How 说 *is written, stroke by stroke*

说

Two pieces, left before right.

The speech piece, 讠, two strokes, as in 请: a dot, then a short horizontal that turns down and finishes rising to the upper right, all one stroke.

The right piece, seven strokes, top to bottom. A dot and a short left-falling stroke, leaning in toward each other. 口 under them. Then two legs: a left-falling stroke, and a vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up.

2 + 7 = nine, and five of them are 讠 and 口.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 说, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 说? (**Two** — 讠, then the right side.) Which character you know is in the middle of the right side? (口.) How

does the last stroke end? (**It hooks up**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 说, pinned stroke paths and medians.

53.3 话 (huà) — words; speech

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ear, then the Mandarin for to say.

You'll want to know: 话

话 — *huà* — "words; speech".

他说中国话 *tā shuō Zhōngguó huà* — He speaks Chinese.

The new character, in pieces: 话 — 讠 on the left; on the right a short fall, a bar and a vertical, standing on 口. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

话 (*huà*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'talk'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: huà*
- *Say it: huà*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō Zhōngguó huà* — He speaks Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ear, then the Mandarin for to say, then say *huà* again

Before you move on

What does 话 mean? ("Words; speech".) Say it once more.

53.4 话 — the speech piece, then a mouth

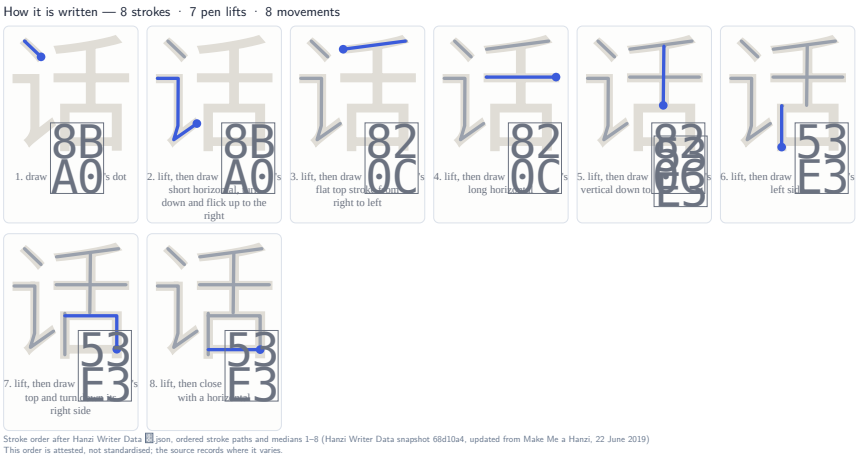
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *huà* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  说 语

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shuō*, *yǔ*

Script — the speech piece, then a mouth



How 话 *is written, stroke by stroke*

话

Two pieces, left before right.
The speech piece, 讠, two strokes, as in 说.
The right piece, six strokes, top to bottom. A short left-falling stroke along the top. A long horizontal. A vertical down from the top through the bar. Then 口 at the foot.
2 + 3 + 3 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 话, all eight, with the model in front of you

- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 话? (**Two** — 讠 , then the right side.) What does the right side stand on? (口.) Which character did your hand write a moment ago, with the same left piece? (说.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 话, pinned stroke paths and medians.

53.5 tīng — to listen; to hear

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to say, then the Mandarin for spoken words.

You'll want to know: tīng

tīng — "to listen; to hear".

nǐ tīng wǒ shuō — Listen to me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tīng is inherited from Middle Chinese *theng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to listen'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīng*
- *Say it: tīng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ tīng wǒ shuō* — Listen to me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to say, then the Mandarin for spoken words, then say *tīng* again

Before you move on

What does tīng mean? (“To listen; to hear”.) Say it once more.

53.6 dǒng — to understand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for spoken words, then the Mandarin for to listen.

You’ll want to know: dǒng

dǒng — “to understand”.

wǒ bù dǒng — I don’t understand.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǒng has no older form in any dictionary we use, so its history is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǒng*
- *Say it: dǒng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù dǒng* — I don’t understand.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for spoken words, then the Mandarin for to listen, then say *dǒng* again

Before you move on

What does dǒng mean? (“To understand”.) Say it once more.

53.7 màn — slow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to listen, then the Mandarin for to understand.

You'll want to know: màn

màn — "slow".

tā shuō huà hěn màn — He speaks slowly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

màn is inherited from Middle Chinese *maenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'lazy, haughty'. The sense 'slow' is not given there; from lazy to slow is a likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: màn*
- *Say it: màn*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō huà hěn màn* — He speaks slowly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to listen, then the Mandarin for to understand, then say *màn* again

Before you move on

What does màn mean? ("Slow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Learning

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I study, read and ask about in class.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 54: I can say what I study, read and ask about in class.*

54.1 xuéxí — to study; to learn

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to understand, then the Mandarin for slow.

You'll want to know: xuéxí

xuéxí — "to study; to learn".

> *wǒ xuéxí hànyǔ* — I'm learning Chinese.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuéxí is built from 学 'to learn' and xí 'to practise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haewk* and *zip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses *zip* with the first.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuéxí*
- *Say it: xuéxí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xuéxí hànyǔ* — I'm learning Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to understand, then the Mandarin for slow, then say *xuéxí* again

Before you move on

What does xuéxí mean? ("To study; to learn".) Say it once more.

54.2 xiě — to write

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for slow, then the Mandarin for to learn.

You'll want to know: xiě

xiě — "to write".

wǒ xiě hànzì — I'm practising characters.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiě is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to remove' and 'to copy out a book'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiě*
- *Say it: xiě*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiě hànzì* — I'm practising characters.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for slow, then the Mandarin for to learn, then say *xiě* again

Before you move on

What does xiě mean? ("To write".) Say it once more.

54.3 dú — to read aloud; to study

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to learn, then the Mandarin for to write.

You'll want to know: dú

dú — "to read aloud; to study".

wǒ xǐhuan dú shū — I love reading.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dú is inherited from Middle Chinese *duwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to recite'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: dú*
- *Say it: dú*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan dú shū* — I love reading.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to learn, then the Mandarin for to write, then say *dú* again

Before you move on

What does dú mean? ("To read aloud; to study".) Say it once more.

54.4 wèn — to ask

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to write, then the Mandarin for to read aloud.

You'll want to know: wèn

wèn — "to ask".

wǒ wèn lǎoshī — I'll ask the teacher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wèn is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to inquire'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: wèn*
- *Say it: wèn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wèn lǎoshī* — I'll ask the teacher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to write, then the Mandarin for to read aloud, then say *wèn* again

Before you move on

What does wèn mean? (“To ask”.) Say it once more.

54.5 kè — lesson; class

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to read aloud, then the Mandarin for to ask.

You’ll want to know: kè

kè — “lesson; class”.

jīntiān yǒu hànyǔ kè — There’s a Chinese class today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kè is inherited from Middle Chinese *khwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’a tax’ and ’a test’. The sense ’lesson’ is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: kè*
- *Say it: kè*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān yǒu hànyǔ kè* — There’s a Chinese class today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to read aloud, then the Mandarin for to ask, then say *kè* again

Before you move on

What does kè mean? (“Lesson; class”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

What You Love

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I would like to do and what I love.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 55: I can say what I would like to do and what I love.*

55.1 想 (xiǎng) — to want to; to think; to miss

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ask, then the Mandarin for lesson.

You'll want to know: 想

想 — *xiǎng* — "to want to; to think; to miss".

> 我想说中国话 *wǒ xiǎng shuō Zhōngguó huà* — I'd like to speak Chinese.

The new character, in pieces: 想 — a tree piece and an eye piece side by side, over a heart piece. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

xiǎng before another verb says what you would like to do: *wǒ xiǎng shuō*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

想 (*xiǎng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to think'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎng*
- *Say it: xiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng shuō Zhōngguó huà* — I'd like to speak Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ask, then the Mandarin for lesson, then say *xiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 想 mean? ("To want to; to think; to miss".) Say it once more.

55.2 想 — a tree and an eye, over a heart

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  看 说

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kàn*, *shuō*

Script — a tree and an eye, over a heart

How 想 *is written, stroke by stroke*

想

Three pieces: the tree, then the eye, then the heart below. Count three, not thirteen.

The tree, four strokes, narrow on the top left: a horizontal, a vertical through it, a left-falling stroke, and a dot.

The eye, five strokes, on the top right: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, and three short horizontals inside, the last one closing it. It is the box at the bottom of 看.

The heart, four strokes, wide underneath: a dot, a long curve that sweeps right and hooks up, then two more dots.

4 + 5 + 4 = thirteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 想, all thirteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 想? (**Three** — the tree, the eye, the heart.) Which character you know has the same eye in it? (看.) What does the heart begin with? (**A dot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 想, pinned stroke paths and medians.

55.3 ài — to love

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lesson, then the Mandarin for to want to.

You'll want to know: ài

ài — "to love".

wǒ ài nǐ — I love you.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ài is inherited from Middle Chinese *'ojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to cherish'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: ài*
- *Say it: ài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ ài nǐ* — I love you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lesson, then the Mandarin for to want to, then say *ài* again

Before you move on

What does ài mean? ("To love".) Say it once more.

55.4 diànyǐng — film; movie

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to want to, then the Mandarin for to love.

You'll want to know: diànyǐng

diànyǐng — "film; movie".

wǒ xǐhuan kàn diànyǐng — I like going to the cinema.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diànyǐng is built from diàn 'lightning', now 'electricity', and yǐng 'shadow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *'jaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): electric shadows.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: diànyǐng*
- *Say it: diànyǐng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan kàn diànyǐng* — I like going to the cinema.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to want to, then the Mandarin for to love, then say *diànyǐng* again

Before you move on

What does diànyǐng mean? ("Film; movie".) Say it once more.

55.5 chànggē — to sing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to love, then the Mandarin for film.

You'll want to know: chànggē

chànggē — "to sing".

tā xǐhuan chànggē — She loves singing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chànggē is built from chàng 'to strike up a song' and gē 'song', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhangH* and *ka* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chànggē*
- *Say it: chànggē*, once more
- *Say it: tā xǐhuan chànggē* — She loves singing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to love, then the Mandarin for film, then say *chànggē* again

Before you move on

What does chànggē mean? ("To sing".) Say it once more.

55.6 kāfēi — coffee

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for film, then the Mandarin for to sing.

You'll want to know: kāfēi

kāfēi — "coffee".

nǐ hē kāfēi ma — Do you drink coffee?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāfēi is borrowed from a European word for coffee; it is usually traced to English *coffee*, though the path is not documented in what we can open.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāfēi*
- *Say it: kāfēi*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ hē kāfēi ma* — Do you drink coffee?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for film, then the Mandarin for to sing, then say *kāfēi* again

Before you move on

What does kāfēi mean? ("Coffee".) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

Free Time

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I do for fun: play, sport, running and laughing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 56: I can say what I do for fun: play, sport, running and laughing.*

56.1 wán — to play; to have fun

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sing, then the Mandarin for coffee.

You'll want to know: wán

wán — "to play; to have fun".

> *háizi xǐhuan wán* — Children love to play.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wán is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to toy with'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: wán*
- *Say it: wán*, once more
- *Say it: háizi xǐhuan wán* — Children love to play.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sing, then the Mandarin for coffee, then say *wán* again

Before you move on

What does wán mean? ("To play; to have fun".) Say it once more.

56.2 dǎqiú — to play ball

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for coffee, then the Mandarin for to play.

You'll want to know: dǎqiú

dǎqiú — "to play ball".

xīngqītiān wǒmen dǎqiú — We play ball on Sunday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎqiú is built from dǎ 'to strike' and qiú 'ball', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), though dǎ is not the sound *taengX* would regularly give. The dictionary glosses *gjuw* as 'fine jade', and under another way of writing it as a ball of fur that is struck.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎqiú*
- *Say it: dǎqiú*, once more
- *Say it: xīngqītiān wǒmen dǎqiú* — We play ball on Sunday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for coffee, then the Mandarin for to play, then say *dǎqiú* again

Before you move on

What does dǎqiú mean? ("To play ball".) Say it once more.

56.3 yùndòng — sport; exercise

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to play, then the Mandarin for to play ball.

You'll want to know: yùndòng

yùndòng — "sport; exercise".

wǒ xǐhuan yùndòng — I like sport.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùndòng is built from yùn 'to move round, to carry' and dòng 'to move', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjunH* and *duwngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The sense 'sport' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùndòng*
- *Say it: yùndòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan yùndòng* — I like sport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to play, then the Mandarin for to play ball, then say *yùndòng* again

Before you move on

What does yùndòng mean? ("Sport; exercise".) Say it once more.

56.4 pǎobù — to run; to jog

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to play ball, then the Mandarin for sport.

You'll want to know: pǎobù

pǎobù — "to run; to jog".

wǒ zǎoshang pǎobù — I go for a run in the mornings.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pǎobù is built from pǎo 'to run' and bù 'step', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *baew* and *buH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses *baew* as a foot pawing the ground.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: pǎobù*
- *Say it: pǎobù*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ zǎoshang pǎobù* — I go for a run in the mornings.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to play ball, then the Mandarin for sport, then say *pǎobù* again

Before you move on

What does pǎobù mean? ("To run; to jog".) Say it once more.

56.5 xiào — to laugh; to smile

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sport, then the Mandarin for to run.

You'll want to know: xiào

xiào — "to laugh; to smile".

tā xiào le — She laughed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiào is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'glad, joyful'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiào*
- *Say it: xiào*, once more
- *Say it: tā xiào le* — She laughed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sport, then the Mandarin for to run, then say *xiào* again

Before you move on

What does xiào mean? (“To laugh; to smile”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

At Home

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my house, my room and the things in it, and say here.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 57: I can name my house, my room and the things in it, and say here.*

57.1 fángzi — house

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to run, then the Mandarin for to laugh.

You'll want to know: fángzi

fángzi — "house".

> *zhè shì wǒ de fángzi* — This is my house.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fángzi is built from fáng 'room' and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjang* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: fángzi*
- *Say it: fángzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de fángzi* — This is my house.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to run, then the Mandarin for to laugh, then say *fángzi* again

Before you move on

What does fángzi mean? ("House".) Say it once more.

57.2 fángjiān — room

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to laugh, then the Mandarin for house.

You'll want to know: fángjiān

fángjiān — "room".

wǒ de fángjiān hěn xiǎo — My room is small.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fángjiān is built from fáng 'room' and jiān 'space between', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjang* and *kean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the second under an older form of the character, glossed 'a gap'.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: fángjiān*
- *Say it: fángjiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de fángjiān hěn xiǎo* — My room is small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to laugh, then the Mandarin for house, then say *fángjiān* again

Before you move on

What does fángjiān mean? ("Room".) Say it once more.

57.3 zhuōzi — table

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for house, then the Mandarin for room.

You'll want to know: zhuōzi

zhuōzi — "table".

wǒ de zhuōzi hěn dà — My desk is big.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuōzi is built from zhuō and the noun ending zi. The Guangyun lists the first character as *traewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), an old way of writing a word for 'high'; the table sense is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuōzi*
- *Say it: zhuōzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de zhuōzi hěn dà* — My desk is big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for house, then the Mandarin for room, then say *zhuōzi* again

Before you move on

What does zhuōzi mean? ("Table".) Say it once more.

57.4 yǐzi — chair

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for room, then the Mandarin for table.

You'll want to know: yǐzi

yǐzi — "chair".

zhè shì háizi de yǐzi — This is the child's chair.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǐzi is built from yǐ and the noun ending zi. The Guangyun records the first character as *'jeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and in a second reading as the name of a tree; the chair sense is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐzi*
- *Say it: yǐzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì háizi de yǐzi* — This is the child's chair.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for room, then the Mandarin for table, then say *yǐzi* again

Before you move on

What does yǐzi mean? ("Chair".) Say it once more.

57.5 这儿 (zhèr) — here

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for table, then the Mandarin for chair.

You'll want to know: 这儿

这儿 — *zhèr* — "here".

你想来这儿吗 *nǐ xiǎng lái zhèr ma* — Would you like to come here?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

这儿 (*zhèr*) is built from 这 'this' and 儿, the ending that runs into the syllable before it as an r.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèr*
- *Say it: zhèr*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xiǎng lái zhèr ma* — Would you like to come here?

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for table, then the Mandarin for chair, then say *zhèr* again

Before you move on

What does 这儿 mean? ("Here".) Say it once more.

57.6 Looking back: from Speaking and Hearing to At Home

Say the Mandarin for to say and spoken words.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to say, spoken words, to listen, to understand, slow
- *Say it:* to learn, to write, to read aloud, to ask, lesson
- *Say it:* to want to, to love, film, to sing, coffee
- *Say it:* to play, to play ball, sport, to run, to laugh
- *Say it:* house, room, table, chair, here
- *Read it:* 说 话 想 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To say? (说, *shuō.*) Spoken words? (话, *huà.*) To listen? (*tīng.*) To understand? (*dǒng.*) Slow? (*màn.*) To learn? (*xuéxí.*) To write? (*xiě.*) To read aloud? (*dú.*) To ask? (*wèn.*) Lesson? (*kè.*) To want to? (想, *xiǎng.*) To love? (*ài.*) Film? (*diànyǐng.*) To sing? (*chànggē.*) Coffee? (*kāfēi.*) To play? (*wán.*) To play ball? (*dǎqiú.*) Sport? (*yùndòng.*) To run? (*pǎobù.*) To laugh? (*xiào.*) House? (*fángzi.*) Room? (*fángjiān.*) Table? (*zhuōzi.*) Chair? (*yǐzi.*) Here? (这儿, *zhèr.*)

57.7 At Home — once more

Say the Mandarin for house and room.

Your turn

- *Say it:* house, room, table, chair, here

Before you move on

House? (*fángzi.*) Room? (*fángjiān.*) Table? (*zhuōzi.*) Chair? (*yǐzi.*) Here? (这儿, *zhèr.*)

Chapter 58

Things You Carry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my phone, my bag, my computer, a cup and my clothes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 58: I can name my phone, my bag, my computer, a cup and my clothes.*

58.1 手机 (shǒujī) — mobile phone

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for chair, then the Mandarin for here.

You'll want to know: 手机

手机 — *shǒujī* — "mobile phone".

> 这是我的手机 *zhè shì wǒ de shǒujī* — This is my phone.

The new character, in pieces: 机 — the tree piece on the left, the one at the top left of 想, and on the right a two-stroke piece read jǐ, as in the word for how many. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

手机 (*shǒujī*) is built from 手 'hand' and 机 'machine'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains as the catch that sets off

a crossbow. From that catch to any machine is the usual explanation, but the step is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒujī*
- *Say it: shǒujī*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de shǒujī* — This is my phone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for chair, then the Mandarin for here, then say *shǒujī* again

Before you move on

What does 手机 mean? ("Mobile phone".) Say it once more.

58.2 机 — the tree piece, then jǐ

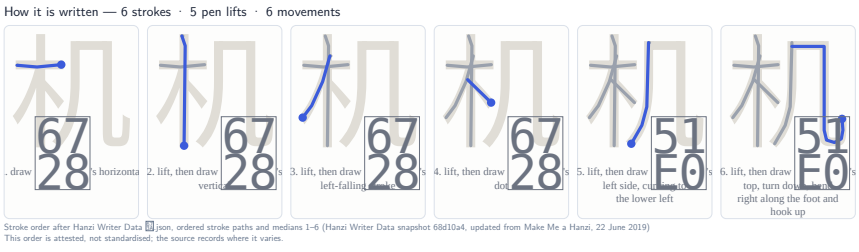
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shǒujī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  手 想

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shǒu*, *xiǎng*

Script — the tree piece, then jǐ



How 机 is written, stroke by stroke

机

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The tree piece, four strokes, narrow on the left, as at the top left of 想: a horizontal, a vertical down through it, a left-falling stroke, and a dot.

The right piece, two strokes, read jǐ, as in the word for how many: a left-falling stroke down the left side, then one stroke that runs across the top, turns down, bends right along the bottom and hooks up.

4 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 机, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 机? (**Two** — the tree piece, then jǐ.) Which character you know has the same tree piece? (想.) How does the last stroke end? (**It runs along the bottom and hooks up**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 机, pinned stroke paths and medians.

58.3 bāo — bag

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for here, then the Mandarin for mobile phone.

You'll want to know: bāo

bāo — "bag".

wǒ xiǎng mǎi yí ge bāo — I'd like to buy a bag.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bāo is inherited from Middle Chinese *paew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to wrap'. The sense 'bag' is not given there; a thing that wraps is the likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāo*
- *Say it: bāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng mǎi yí ge bāo* — I'd like to buy a bag.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for here, then the Mandarin for mobile phone, then say *bāo* again

Before you move on

What does bāo mean? ("Bag".) Say it once more.

58.4 diànnǎo — computer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for mobile phone, then the Mandarin for bag.

You'll want to know: diànnǎo

diànnǎo — "computer".

wǒ xǐhuan wán diànnǎo — I like playing on the computer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diànnǎo is built from diàn 'lightning', now 'electricity', and nǎo 'brain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *nawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): an electric brain.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: diànnǎo*
- *Say it: diànnǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan wán diànnǎo* — I like playing on the computer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for mobile phone, then the Mandarin for bag, then say *diànnǎo* again

Before you move on

What does diànnǎo mean? ("Computer".) Say it once more.

58.5 bēizi — cup; glass

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bag, then the Mandarin for computer.

You'll want to know: bēizi

bēizi — "cup; glass".

zhè shì nǐ de bēizi ma — Is this your cup?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bēizi is built from bēi and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwoj* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the first, through an older book, as a kind of vessel.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: bēizi*
- *Say it: bēizi*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì nǐ de bēizi ma* — Is this your cup?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bag, then the Mandarin for computer, then say *bēizi* again

Before you move on

What does bēizi mean? ("Cup; glass".) Say it once more.

58.6 yīfu — clothes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for computer, then the Mandarin for cup.

You'll want to know: yīfu

yīfu — "clothes".

wǒ xǐhuan mǎi yīfu — I love buying clothes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīfu is built from yī and fu, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'j+j* and *bjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the garment worn on the upper body, and lists 'clothes' among the senses of the second.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīfu*
- *Say it: yīfu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan mǎi yīfu* — I love buying clothes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for computer, then the Mandarin for cup, then say *yīfu* again

Before you move on

What does yīfu mean? (“Clothes”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Clothes

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I wear: shoes, a hat and trousers, and that they look nice.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 59: I can say what I wear: shoes, a hat and trousers, and that they look nice.*

59.1 chuān — to wear; to put on

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cup, then the Mandarin for clothes.

You'll want to know: chuān

chuān — "to wear; to put on".

> *míngtiān nǐ chuān shénme* — What are you wearing tomorrow?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuān is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to go through' and 'a hole'. Wearing is not given there; putting arms and legs through clothes is the usual explanation, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuān*
- *Say it: chuān*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān nǐ chuān shénme* — What are you wearing tomorrow?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cup, then the Mandarin for clothes, then say *chuān* again

Before you move on

What does chuān mean? ("To wear; to put on".) Say it once more.

59.2 xié — shoe

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for clothes, then the Mandarin for to wear.

You'll want to know: xié

xié — "shoe".

wǒ de jiǎo hěn dà xié hěn xiǎo — My feet are big and the shoes are small.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xié is inherited from Middle Chinese *heaj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'shoe'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: xié*
- *Say it: xié*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de jiǎo hěn dà xié hěn xiǎo* — My feet are big and the shoes are small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for clothes, then the Mandarin for to wear, then say *xié* again

Before you move on

What does xié mean? ("Shoe".) Say it once more.

59.3 màozi — hat; cap

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wear, then the Mandarin for shoe.

You'll want to know: màozi

màozi — "hat; cap".

wǒ de tóu hěn dà màozi tài xiǎo le — My head's big; the hat is too small.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

màozi is built from mào and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mawH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a covering for the head.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: màozi*
- *Say it: màozi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de tóu hěn dà màozi tài xiǎo le* — My head's big; the hat is too small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wear, then the Mandarin for shoe, then say *màozi* again

Before you move on

What does màozi mean? ("Hat; cap".) Say it once more.

59.4 kùzi — trousers

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for shoe, then the Mandarin for hat.

You'll want to know: kùzi

kùzi — "trousers".

zhè shì wǒ gēge de kùzi — These are my brother's trousers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kùzi is built from kù and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under a variant form of the character and explains it, through an older book, as a garment for the shins.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: kùzi*
- *Say it: kùzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ gēge de kùzi* — These are my brother's trousers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for shoe, then the Mandarin for hat, then say *kùzi* again

Before you move on

What does kùzi mean? ("Trousers".) Say it once more.

59.5 piàoliang — pretty; good-looking

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hat, then the Mandarin for trousers.

You'll want to know: piàoliang

piàoliang — "pretty; good-looking".

tā de yǎnjing hěn piàoliang — She has beautiful eyes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

piàoliang is built from piào and liang, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phjiewH* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as beating silk floss in water and the second as 'bright'; how the pair came to mean pretty is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: piàoliang*
- *Say it: piàoliang*, once more
- *Say it: tā de yǎnjing hěn piàoliang* — She has beautiful eyes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hat, then the Mandarin for trousers, then say *piàoliang* again

Before you move on

What does piàoliang mean? ("Pretty; good-looking".) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Colours

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name white, red, black and blue, and ask about colours.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 60: I can name white, red, black and blue, and ask about colours.*

60.1 白 (bái) — white; pale

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for trousers, then the Mandarin for pretty.

You'll want to know: 白

白 — *bái* — "white; pale".

> 他的手很白 *tā de shǒu hěn bái* — His hands are very pale.

The new character, in pieces: 白 — a short fall on top of 日. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

白 (*bái*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *baek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the colour of the west', the direction that the old scheme of five colours paired with white.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: bái*
- *Say it: bái*, once more
- *Say it: tā de shǒu hěn bái* — His hands are very pale.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for trousers, then the Mandarin for pretty, then say *bái* again

Before you move on

What does 白 mean? ("White; pale".) Say it once more.

60.2 白 — a short fall over 日

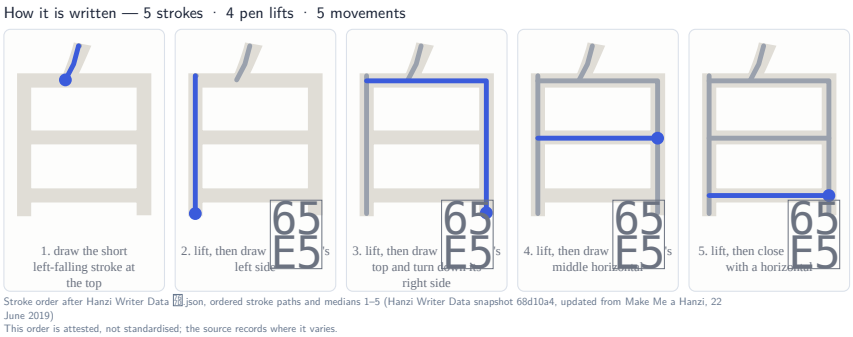
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bái* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

日 百

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *bǎi*

Script — a short fall over 日



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–5 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 白 is written, stroke by stroke

白

Two pieces, top to bottom.
A short left-falling stroke at the top, from the right down to the left.
日, four strokes, the same four your hand makes in 日: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, and the bar that closes the bottom.
1 + 4 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 白, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 白? (**Five**.) What comes before 日? (**A short fall at the top**.) Which number you know has 白 under its top bar? (百.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 白, pinned stroke paths and medians.

60.3 yánsè — colour

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pretty, then the Mandarin for white.

You'll want to know: yánsè

yánsè — "colour".

wǒ ài zhège yánsè — I love this colour.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yánsè is built from yán 'face' and sè, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngaen* and *srik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second with the whole word, 'colour'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: yánsè*
- *Say it: yánsè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ ài zhège yánsè* — I love this colour.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pretty, then the Mandarin for white, then say *yánsè* again

Before you move on

What does yánsè mean? ("Colour".) Say it once more.

60.4 hóng — red

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for white, then the Mandarin for colour.

You'll want to know: hóng

hóng — "red".

zhège píngguǒ hěn hóng — This apple is really red.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hóng is inherited from Middle Chinese *huwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a colour'; which colour is not said there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: hóng*
- *Say it: hóng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège píngguǒ hěn hóng* — This apple is really red.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for white, then the Mandarin for colour, then say *hóng* again

Before you move on

What does hóng mean? ("Red".) Say it once more.

60.5 hēi — black; dark

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for colour, then the Mandarin for red.

You'll want to know: hēi

hēi — "black; dark".

nàge fángjiān hěn hēi — That room is dark.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hēi is inherited from Middle Chinese *xok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the colour of the north', which the old scheme of five colours paired with black.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: hēi*
- *Say it: hēi*, once more
- *Say it: nàge fángjiān hěn hēi* — That room is dark.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for colour, then the Mandarin for red, then say *hēi* again

Before you move on

What does hēi mean? ("Black; dark".) Say it once more.

60.6 lán — blue

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for red, then the Mandarin for black.

You'll want to know: lán

lán — "blue".

tā de yǎnjing hěn lán — Her eyes are very blue.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lán is inherited from Middle Chinese *lam* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a plant for dye'. The colour is not given there; blue as the colour of that dye is the likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: lán*
- *Say it: lán*, once more

- *Say it: tā de yǎnjing hěn lán* — Her eyes are very blue.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for red, then the Mandarin for black, then say *lán* again

Before you move on

What does lán mean? (“Blue”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

Long and Short

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say long, short, tall, short of height, and new.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 61: I can say long, short, tall, short of height, and new.*

61.1 长 (cháng) — long

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for black, then the Mandarin for blue.

You'll want to know: 长

长 — *cháng* — "long".

> *jīntiān de diànyǐng hěn cháng* — Today's film is a long one.

The new character, in pieces: 长 — four strokes: a short fall, a long bar, a vertical that flicks up at the foot, and a sweep down to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

长 (*cháng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'lasting', 'far' and 'for ever'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: cháng*
- *Say it: cháng*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de diànyǐng hěn cháng* — Today's film is a long one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for black, then the Mandarin for blue, then say *cháng* again

Before you move on

What does 长 mean? ("Long".) Say it once more.

61.2 长 — four strokes in one piece

The word first, then the character inside it.

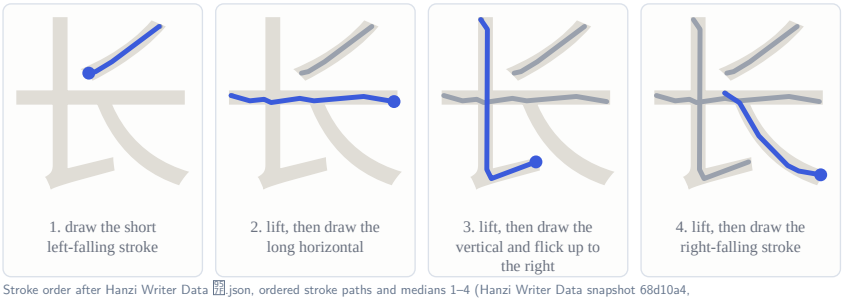
- *Recall:* say *cháng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

大 八

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *bā*

Script — four strokes in one piece

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 🈸.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–4 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 长 is written, stroke by stroke

长

One piece, four strokes.
A short left-falling stroke at the top right, falling toward the left.
A long horizontal across the middle.
A vertical from the top left, down through the bar, that turns and flicks up to the right at the foot.
A long stroke falling to the right, from the bar down to the bottom right.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 长, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 长? (**Four**.) Which stroke flicks up at the foot? (**The vertical, the third**.) Which way does the last one fall? (**Down to the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 长, pinned stroke paths and medians.

61.3 duǎn — short in length; brief

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for blue, then the Mandarin for long.

You'll want to know: duǎn

duǎn — "short in length; brief".

wǒ de kùzi hěn duǎn — My trousers are short.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duǎn is inherited from Middle Chinese *twanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'hurried' and 'not long'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: duǎn*
- *Say it: duǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de kùzi hěn duǎn* — My trousers are short.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for blue, then the Mandarin for long, then say *duǎn* again

Before you move on

What does duǎn mean? ("Short in length; brief".) Say it once more.

61.4 gāo — tall; high

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for long, then the Mandarin for short in length.

You'll want to know: gāo

gāo — "tall; high".

wǒ gēge hěn gāo tā xǐhuan yùndòng — My brother is tall, and he loves sport.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gāo is inherited from Middle Chinese *kaw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'up', 'lofty' and 'far'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāo*
- *Say it: gāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēge hěn gāo tā xǐhuan yùndòng* — My brother is tall, and he loves sport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for long, then the Mandarin for short in length, then say *gāo* again

Before you move on

What does gāo mean? ("Tall; high".) Say it once more.

61.5 ǎi — short in height; low

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for short in length, then the Mandarin for tall.

You'll want to know: ǎi

ǎi — "short in height; low".

wǒ mèimei hěn ǎi — My little sister is short.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ǎi is inherited from Middle Chinese *'eaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'short to look at'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: ǎi*
- *Say it: ǎi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mèimei hěn ǎi* — My little sister is short.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for short in length, then the Mandarin for tall, then say *ǎi* again

Before you move on

What does ǎi mean? ("Short in height; low".) Say it once more.

61.6 xīn — new

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tall, then the Mandarin for short in height.

You'll want to know: xīn

xīn — "new".

zhè shì wǒ de xīn shǒujī — This is my new phone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīn is inherited from Middle Chinese *sin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'new, as against old'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīn*
- *Say it: xīn*, once more

- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de xīn shǒujī* — This is my new phone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tall, then the Mandarin for short in height, then say *xīn* again

Before you move on

What does xīn mean? (“New”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Fast, Far and Near

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say fast, old, far and near, and say that I know something.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 62: I can say fast, old, far and near, and say that I know something.*

62.1 快 (kuài) — fast; quick

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for short in height, then the Mandarin for new.

You'll want to know: 快

快 — *kuài* — "fast; quick".

> 我的手机很快 *wǒ de shǒujī hěn kuài* — My phone is fast.

The new character, in pieces: 快 — on the left the heart piece from the foot of 想, standing upright, and on the right a four-stroke piece read guài. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

快 (*kuài*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *khwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to one's liking' and 'glad'. The sense 'fast' is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuài*
- *Say it: kuài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shǒujī hěn kuài* — My phone is fast.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for short in height, then the Mandarin for new, then say *kuài* again

Before you move on

What does 快 mean? ("Fast; quick".) Say it once more.

62.2 快 — the upright heart, then guài

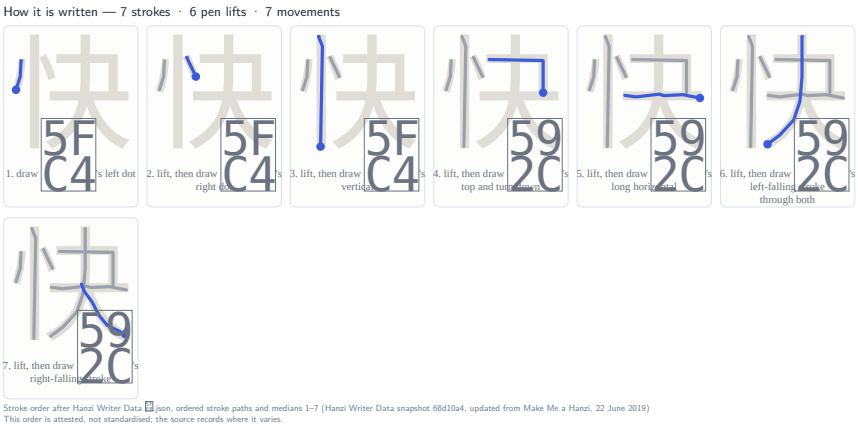
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kuài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  想 大

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xiǎng*, *dà*

Script — the upright heart, then guài



How 快 *is written, stroke by stroke*

快

Two pieces, left before right.

The upright heart piece, three strokes: a short dot on the left, a short dot on the right, then a long vertical down between them: the heart piece from the foot of 想, standing upright.

The right piece, four strokes, read guài: a horizontal that turns down at its right end, a long horizontal across, a long left-falling stroke from the top down through the bars, and a stroke falling to the right.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 快, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 快? (**Two**.) Which dot comes first? (**The left one**.) How many strokes on the right side? (**Four**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 快, pinned stroke paths and medians.

62.3 jiù — old (of things); no longer new

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for new, then the Mandarin for fast.

You'll want to know: jiù

jiù — "old (of things); no longer new".

wǒ de chē hěn jiù — My car is old.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiù is inherited from Middle Chinese *gjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'former, of old'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiù*
- *Say it: jiù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de chē hěn jiù* — My car is old.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for new, then the Mandarin for fast, then say *jiù* again

Before you move on

What does jiù mean? ("Old (of things); no longer new".) Say it once more.

62.4 yuǎn — far

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fast, then the Mandarin for no longer new.

You'll want to know: yuǎn

yuǎn — "far".

Běijīng hěn yuǎn — Beijing is a long way away.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuǎn is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjwonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'distant'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuǎn*
- *Say it: yuǎn*, once more
- *Say it: Běijīng hěn yuǎn* — Beijing is a long way away.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fast, then the Mandarin for no longer new, then say *yuǎn* again

Before you move on

What does yuǎn mean? ("Far".) Say it once more.

62.5 jìn — near; close

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for no longer new, then the Mandarin for far.

You'll want to know: jìn

jìn — "near; close".

wǒ jiā hěn jìn — My home is close by.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìn is inherited from Middle Chinese *gj+nX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'pressing close' and 'almost'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìn*
- *Say it: jìn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā hěn jìn* — My home is close by.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for no longer new, then the Mandarin for far, then say *jìn* again

Before you move on

What does jìn mean? ("Near; close".) Say it once more.

62.6 zhīdào — to know a fact; to be aware

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for far, then the Mandarin for near.

You'll want to know: zhīdào

zhīdào — "to know a fact; to be aware".

wǒ zhīdào nǐ xiǎng shuō shénme — I know what you want to say.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhīdào is built from zhī 'to perceive' and dào 'the way', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trje* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How the pair came to mean knowing a fact is not

settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhīdào*
- *Say it: zhīdào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhīdào nǐ xiǎng shuō shénme* — I know what you want to say.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for far, then the Mandarin for near, then say *zhīdào* again

Before you move on

What does zhīdào mean? ("To know a fact; to be aware".) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

On the Phone

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer the phone, ask for a number and say what I am looking for.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 63: I can answer the phone, ask for a number and say what I am looking for.*

63.1 电话 (diànhuà) — telephone; phone call

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for near, then the Mandarin for to know a fact.

You'll want to know: 电话

电话 — *diànhuà* — "telephone; phone call".

> **你有电话吗** *nǐ yǒu diànhuà ma* — Have you got a phone?

The new character, in pieces: **电** — **日** with one long stroke running down through its middle, bending right along the bottom and hooking up. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

电话 (*diànhuà*) is built from **电** 'lightning', now 'electricity', and **话** 'talk', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): electric talk.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: diànhuà*
- *Say it: diànhuà*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu diànhuà ma* — Have you got a phone?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for near, then the Mandarin for to know a fact, then say *diànhuà* again

Before you move on

What does 电话 mean? ("Telephone; phone call".) Say it once more.

63.2 电 — 日 with a long tail

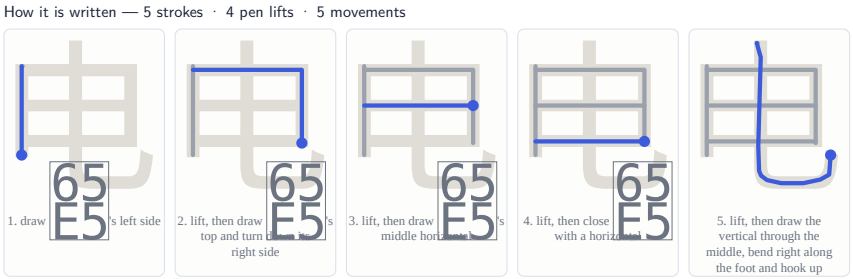
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *diànhuà* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 话

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *huà*

Script — 日 with a long tail



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–5 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 电 is written, stroke by stroke

电

Two parts: the box first, then the tail.

日, four strokes: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, and the bottom bar.

The tail, one stroke: from above the top of the box, a vertical straight down through the middle, bending right along the bottom and hooking up at the end.

4 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 电, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 电? (**Five**.) Which character you know is inside it? (日.) Where does the last stroke start? (**Above the box, and it runs down through the middle**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 电, pinned stroke paths and medians.

63.3 打电话 (dǎ diànhuà) — to phone; to make a phone call

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to know a fact, then the Mandarin for telephone.

You'll want to know: 打电话

打电话 — *dǎ diànhuà* — "to phone; to make a phone call".

我想打电话 *wǒ xiǎng dǎ diànhuà* — I'd like to make a phone call.

The new character, in pieces: 打 — the hand piece, a narrow 手, on the left, and on the right a two-stroke piece read dīng. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

打电话 (*dǎ diànhuà*) is built from dǎ 'to strike' and 电话 'telephone'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *taengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to strike', though dǎ is not the sound *taengX* would regularly give. Making a call is not among its senses there, so how the verb came to do it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎ diànhuà*
- *Say it: dǎ diànhuà*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng dǎ diànhuà* — I'd like to make a phone call.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to know a fact, then the Mandarin for telephone, then say *dǎ diànhuà* again

Before you move on

What does 打电话 mean? ("To phone; to make a phone call".) Say it once more.

63.4 打 — the hand piece, then dīng

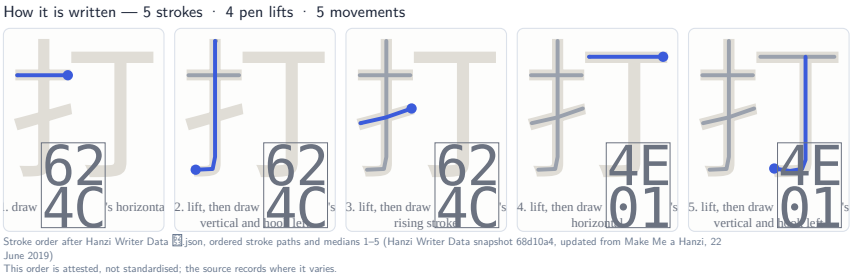
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dǎ diànhuà* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  手 电

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shǒu*, *diàn*

Script — the hand piece, then dīng



How 打 is written, stroke by stroke

打

Two pieces, left before right.

The hand piece, three strokes, a narrow form of 手: a short horizontal, a vertical through it that hooks to the left at the foot, then a stroke that rises from the lower left up across the vertical.

The right piece, two strokes, read dīng: a horizontal across the top, then a vertical down from its middle that hooks to the left.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 打, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 打? (**Two**.) Which character you know is the hand piece a narrow form of? (手.) Which way does the rising stroke run? (**From the lower left up to the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 打, pinned stroke paths and medians.

63.5 wéi — hello on the phone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for telephone, then the Mandarin for to phone.

You'll want to know: wéi

wéi — "hello on the phone".

wéi nǐ tīng wǒ shuō — Hello? Listen to me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
On the phone it is said with a rising tone, as a question: wéi?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wéi is the call you answer the phone with. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: wéi*
- *Say it: wéi*, once more
- *Say it: wéi nǐ tīng wǒ shuō* — Hello? Listen to me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for telephone, then the Mandarin for to phone, then say *wéi* again

Before you move on

What does wéi mean? ("Hello on the phone".) Say it once more.

63.6 hàomǎ — number (of a phone, a room); identifying number

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to phone, then the Mandarin for hello on the phone.

You'll want to know: hàomǎ

hàomǎ — "number (of a phone, a room); identifying number".

> *nǐ de diànhuà hàomǎ shì duōshao* — What's your phone number?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hàomǎ is built from hào and mǎ, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hawH* and *maeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as a call or a command and the second as agate, a stone like jade; how the pair came to mean a number is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: hàomǎ*
- *Say it: hàomǎ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de diànhuà hàomǎ shì duōshao* — What's your phone number?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to phone, then the Mandarin for hello on the phone, then say *hàomǎ* again

Before you move on

What does hàomǎ mean? ("Number (of a phone, a room); identifying number".) Say it once more.

63.7 zhǎo — to look for

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hello on the phone, then the Mandarin for identifying number.

You'll want to know: zhǎo

zhǎo — "to look for".

nǐ zhǎo shénme — What are you looking for?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǎo is the everyday verb for looking for something. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎo*
- *Say it: zhǎo*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zhǎo shénme* — What are you looking for?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hello on the phone, then the Mandarin for identifying number, then say *zhǎo* again

Before you move on

What does zhǎo mean? ("To look for".) Say it once more.

63.8 Looking back: from Things You Carry to On the Phone

Say the Mandarin for mobile phone and bag.

Your turn

- *Say it:* mobile phone, bag, computer, cup, clothes
- *Say it:* to wear, shoe, hat, trousers, pretty

- *Say it:* white, colour, red, black, blue
- *Say it:* long, short in length, tall, short in height, new
- *Say it:* fast, no longer new, far, near, to know a fact
- *Say it:* telephone, to phone, hello on the phone, identifying number, to look for
- *Read it:* 机 白 长 快 电 打 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Mobile phone? (手机, *shǒujī.*) Bag? (*bāo.*) Computer? (*diànnǎo.*) Cup? (*bēizi.*) Clothes? (*yīfu.*) To wear? (*chuān.*) Shoe? (*xié.*) Hat? (*màozi.*) Trousers? (*kùzi.*) Pretty? (*piàoliang.*) White? (白, *bái.*) Colour? (*yánsè.*) Red? (*hóng.*) Black? (*hēi.*) Blue? (*lán.*) Long? (长, *cháng.*) Short in length? (*duǎn.*) Tall? (*gāo.*) Short in height? (*ǎi.*) New? (*xīn.*) Fast? (快, *kuài.*) No longer new? (*jiù.*) Far? (*yuǎn.*) Near? (*jìn.*) To know a fact? (*zhīdào.*) Telephone? (电话, *diànhuà.*) To phone? (打电话, *dǎ diànhuà.*) Hello on the phone? (*wéi.*) Identifying number? (*hàomǎ.*) To look for? (*zhǎo.*)

Chapter 64

Asking for Help

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say sorry, ask for help, borrow something and give it back.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 64: I can say sorry, ask for help, borrow something and give it back.*

64.1 对不起 (duìbuqǐ) — sorry

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for identifying number, then the Mandarin for to look for.

You'll want to know: 对不起

对不起 — *duìbuqǐ* — "sorry".

> *duìbuqǐ wǒ bù dǒng nǐ de huà* — Sorry, I don't understand what you're saying.

The new character, in pieces: 起 — the walking piece read zǒu along the left and the bottom, carrying a three-stroke piece read jǐ, 'self', on its back: not the jǐ of 机. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Its middle syllable loses its tone: duìbuqǐ, with bu light between two full syllables.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

对不起 (*duìbuqǐ*) is built from 对 'to answer, to match', 不 'not' and 起 'to rise', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *twojH*, *pjut* and *khiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'Not able to face you' is the usual explanation, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: duìbuqǐ*
- *Say it: duìbuqǐ*, once more
- *Say it: duìbuqǐ wǒ bù dǒng nǐ de huà* — Sorry, I don't understand what you're saying.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for identifying number, then the Mandarin for to look for, then say *duìbuqǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 对不起 mean? ("Sorry".) Say it once more.

64.2 起 — the walking piece, carrying jǐ

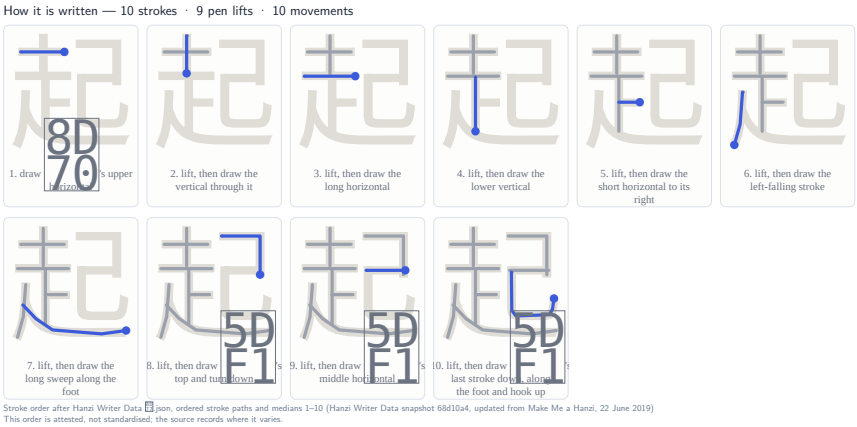
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *duìbuqǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  对 不

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *duì*, *bù*

Script — the walking piece, carrying jǐ



How 起 *is written, stroke by stroke*

起

Two pieces: the walking piece first, then the piece on its back.

The walking piece, seven strokes, read zǒu, as in the word for to walk: a short horizontal, a vertical down through it, a longer horizontal; then below, a short vertical with a short bar to its right, a left-falling stroke, and last a long stroke that sweeps right along the whole bottom.

The right piece, three strokes, read jǐ, 'self', not the jǐ of 机, sitting on the sweep: a horizontal that turns down, a short horizontal, then a vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up.

7 + 3 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 起, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 起? (**Two** — the walking piece and jǐ.) Which stroke runs under the whole character? (**The long sweep, the seventh.**) Which character comes before it in 对不起? (不.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 起, pinned stroke paths and medians.

64.3 bāng — to help

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look for, then the Mandarin for sorry.

You'll want to know: bāng

bāng — "to help".

nǐ bāng wǒ xiě hǎo bu hǎo — Will you help me write it?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bāng is inherited from Middle Chinese *pang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to mend shoes'. The sense 'to help' is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāng*
- *Say it: bāng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bāng wǒ xiě hǎo bu hǎo* — Will you help me write it?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look for, then the Mandarin for sorry, then say *bāng* again

Before you move on

What does bāng mean? ("To help".) Say it once more.

64.4 bāngmáng — to help out; to do a favour

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sorry, then the Mandarin for to help.

You'll want to know: bāngmáng

bāngmáng — "to help out; to do a favour".

wǒ xiǎng bāngmáng — I'd like to help.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bāngmáng is built from bāng 'to help' and máng 'busy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pang* and *mang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses *mang* as 'afraid', so the sense busy is not given there; helping with what keeps somebody busy is the likely picture, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāngmáng*
- *Say it: bāngmáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng bāngmáng* — I'd like to help.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sorry, then the Mandarin for to help, then say *bāngmáng* again

Before you move on

What does bāngmáng mean? ("To help out; to do a favour".) Say it once more.

64.5 jiè — to borrow; to lend

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to help, then the Mandarin for to do a favour.

You'll want to know: jiè

jiè — "to borrow; to lend".

wǒ jiè le tā de shū — I borrowed his book.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiè is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsjaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to borrow'; today the same word also lends.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiè*
- *Say it: jiè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiè le tā de shū* — I borrowed his book.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to help, then the Mandarin for to do a favour, then say *jiè* again

Before you move on

What does jiè mean? ("To borrow; to lend".) Say it once more.

64.6 huán — to give back

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to do a favour, then the Mandarin for to borrow.

You'll want to know: huán

huán — "to give back".

wǒ míngtiān huán nǐ — I'll give it back tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The same character is read hái in hái xíng; here, giving something back, it is huán.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huán is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwaen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to return' and 'to go back'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: huán*
- *Say it: huán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ míngtiān huán nǐ* — I'll give it back tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to do a favour, then the Mandarin for to borrow, then say *huán* again

Before you move on

What does huán mean? ("To give back".) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

Excuse Me

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say excuse me, ask politely, and ask somebody to open or shut something.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 65: I can say excuse me, ask politely, and ask somebody to open or shut something.*

65.1 门 (mén) — door; gate

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to borrow, then the Mandarin for to give back.

You'll want to know: 门

门 — *mén* — "door; gate".

> 这是我家的门 *zhè shì wǒ jiā de mén* — This is the door to my home.

The new character, in pieces: 门 — a dot, a post down the left, and a frame that turns down the right and hooks: the right-hand piece of 们. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

门 (*mén*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary says its old character is made of two door leaves.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: mén*
- *Say it: mén*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ jiā de mén* — This is the door to my home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to borrow, then the Mandarin for to give back, then say *mén* again

Before you move on

What does 门 mean? ("Door; gate".) Say it once more.

65.2 门 — a dot, a post, a frame

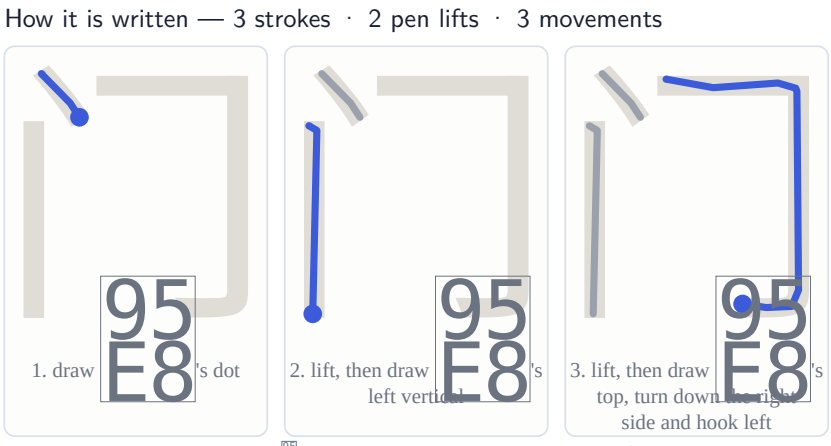
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *mén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  们 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *men*, *kǒu*

Script — a dot, a post, a frame



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 95.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 丶冂 is written, stroke by stroke

丶冂

One piece, three strokes, the same three as on the right of 闩.
A dot at the top left.
A vertical down the left side, the door post.
A horizontal that turns down the right side and hooks to the left at the foot.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 丶冂, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 丶冂? (**Three**.) Which character you know has it on the right? (闩.) How does the last stroke end? (**It hooks to the left**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 门, pinned stroke paths and medians.

65.3 请问 (qǐngwèn) — excuse me, may I ask

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give back, then the Mandarin for door.

You'll want to know: 请问

请问 — *qǐngwèn* — "excuse me, may I ask".

请问这是你的手机吗 *qǐngwèn zhè shì nǐ de shǒujī ma* — Excuse me, is this your phone?

The new character, in pieces: 问 — 门 with 口 inside it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

请问 (*qǐngwèn*) is built from 请 'please' and 问 'to ask', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjengX* and *mjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary already glosses the first as 'to beg, to ask'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐngwèn*
- *Say it: qǐngwèn*, once more
- *Say it: qǐngwèn zhè shì nǐ de shǒujī ma* — Excuse me, is this your phone?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give back, then the Mandarin for door, then say *qǐngwèn* again

Before you move on

What does 请问 mean? ("Excuse me, may I ask".) Say it once more.

65.4 问 — 门 with 口 inside

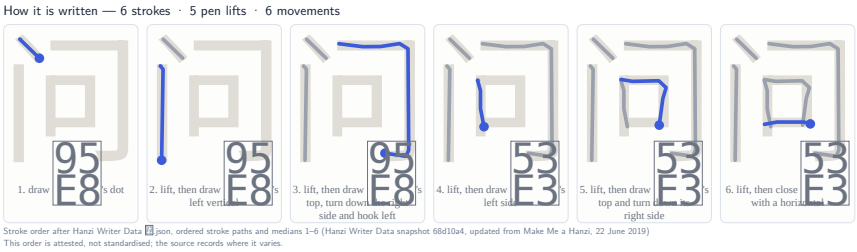
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qǐngwèn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  门 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *mén*, *kǒu*

Script — 门 with 口 inside



How 问 is written, stroke by stroke

问

Two pieces: the door first, then the mouth inside it.

门**, three strokes**: the dot, the left post, the frame that turns down and hooks.

口**, three strokes**, small and inside: the left side, the top that turns down, the bottom that closes it.

3 + 3 = six, and both pieces are already yours.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 问, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 问? (**Two** — 门, then 口.) Which goes first? (门**, the frame**.) Where does 口 sit? (**Inside the door**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 问, pinned stroke paths and medians.

65.5 bù hǎoyìsi — excuse me; sorry to trouble you

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for door, then the Mandarin for may I ask.

You'll want to know: bù hǎoyìsi

bù hǎoyìsi — "excuse me; sorry to trouble you".

bù hǎoyìsi wǒ xiǎng wèn nǐ — Excuse me, could I ask you something?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

bù keeps its own falling tone here, because hǎo after it is a third tone, not a fourth.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bù hǎoyìsi is built from bù 'not', hǎo 'good' and yìsi 'meaning', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut*, *xawX*, *'iH* and *si* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the last two as 'intention' and 'to think of'. 'Not a good feeling' is the literal sense; how it became an apology is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: bù hǎoyìsi*
- *Say it: bù hǎoyìsi*, once more
- *Say it: bù hǎoyìsi wǒ xiǎng wèn nǐ* — Excuse me, could I ask you something?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for door, then the Mandarin for may I ask, then say *bù hǎoyìsi* again

Before you move on

What does bù hǎoyìsi mean? ("Excuse me; sorry to trouble you".) Say it once more.

65.6 kāi — to open; to switch on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for may I ask, then the Mandarin for excuse me.

You'll want to know: kāi

kāi — "to open; to switch on".

shāngdiàn jiǔ diǎn kāi — The shop opens at nine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāi is inherited from Middle Chinese *khoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to open, to undo'.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāi*
- *Say it: kāi*, once more
- *Say it: shāngdiàn jiǔ diǎn kāi* — The shop opens at nine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for may I ask, then the Mandarin for excuse me, then say *kāi* again

Before you move on

What does kāi mean? ("To open; to switch on".) Say it once more.

65.7 guān — to shut; to close; to switch off

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for excuse me, then the Mandarin for to open.

You'll want to know: guān

guān — "to shut; to close; to switch off".

qǐng guān mén — Please shut the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guān is inherited from Middle Chinese *kwaen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains, through an older book, as a wooden bar held across a door. Shutting is probably what the bar does, but the step is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: guān*
- *Say it: guān*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng guān mén* — Please shut the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for excuse me, then the Mandarin for to open, then say *guān* again

Before you move on

What does guān mean? ("To shut; to close; to switch off".) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

The Weather

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what the weather is like: rain, snow and wind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 66: I can say what the weather is like: rain, snow and wind.*

66.1 天气 (tiānqì) — weather

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to open, then the Mandarin for to shut.

You'll want to know: 天气

天气 — *tiānqì* — "weather".

> 今天天气很好 *jīntiān tiānqì hěn hǎo* — The weather is lovely today.

The new character, in pieces: 气 — a short fall, two short bars, and a long stroke that turns, slants out and hooks. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

天气 (*tiānqì*) is built from 天 'sky' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *then* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription): the breath of the sky.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānqì*
- *Say it: tiānqì*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān tiānqì hěn hǎo* — The weather is lovely today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to open, then the Mandarin for to shut, then say *tiānqì* again

Before you move on

What does 天气 mean? ("Weather".) Say it once more.

66.2 气 — a fall, two bars, a hook

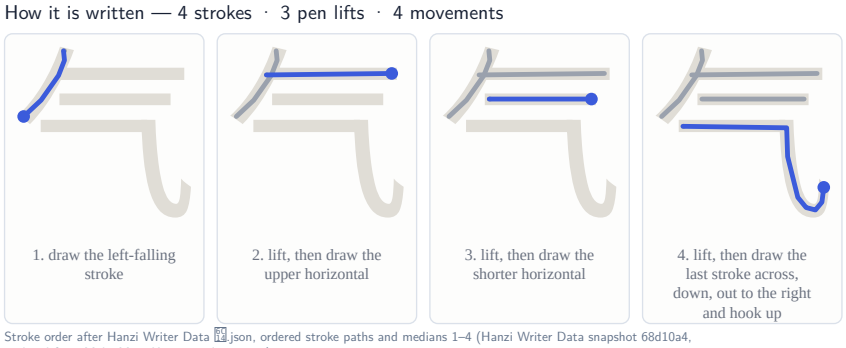
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tiānqì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  天 手

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tiān*, *shǒu*

Script — a fall, two bars, a hook



How 气 is written, stroke by stroke

气

One piece, four strokes.
A short left-falling stroke at the top left.
Two short horizontals under it, the second a little lower and shorter.
A long horizontal that turns down, slants out to the right and hooks up at the end.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 气, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 气? (**Four**.) How many short bars? (**Two**.) How does the last stroke end? (**It slants out and hooks up**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 气, pinned stroke paths and medians.

66.3 雨 (yǔ) — rain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shut, then the Mandarin for weather.

You'll want to know: 雨

雨 — *yǔ* — "rain".

> 请问明天有雨吗 *qǐngwèn míngtiān yǒu yǔ ma* — Excuse me, will it rain tomorrow?

The new character, in pieces: 雨 — a lid, a frame with a line down its middle, and four drops inside. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

雨 (*yǔ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains, through an older book, as water coming down from the clouds.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǔ*
- *Say it: yǔ*, once more
- *Say it: qǐngwèn míngtiān yǒu yǔ ma* — Excuse me, will it rain tomorrow?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shut, then the Mandarin for weather, then say *yǔ* again

Before you move on

What does 雨 mean? ("Rain".) Say it once more.

66.4 雨 — a lid, a frame and four drops

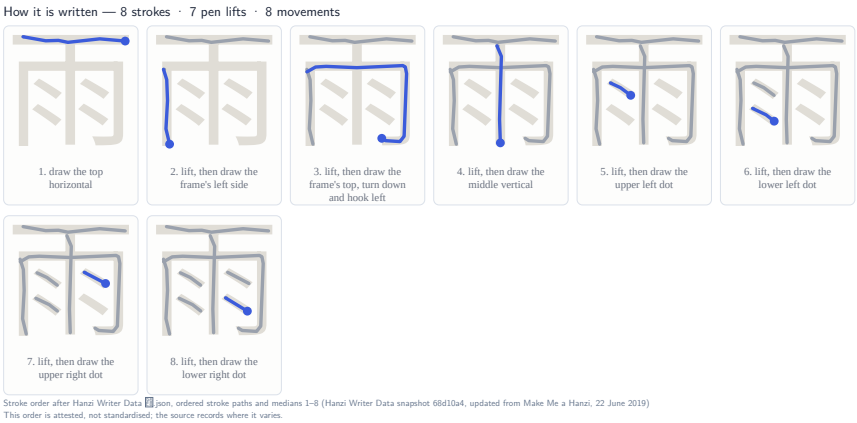
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yǔ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  天 气

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tiān*, *qì*

Script — a lid, a frame and four drops



How 雨 *is written, stroke by stroke*

雨

One piece, built from the top down.
A horizontal across the top, the lid.
A frame, two strokes: a short vertical down the left, then a horizontal that turns down the right side and hooks to the left.
A vertical down the middle from the lid.
Four dots, two on the left of the middle line, then two on the right.
1 + 2 + 1 + 4 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 雨, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 雨? (**Eight**.) What comes last? (**The four dots, the left pair first**.) Which stroke hooks? (**The right side of the frame**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 雨, pinned stroke paths and medians.

66.5 xiàyǔ — to rain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for weather, then the Mandarin for rain.

You'll want to know: xiàyǔ

xiàyǔ — "to rain".

xiàyǔ wǒmen bù dǎqiú — It's raining, so we're not playing ball.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàyǔ is built from xià 'to come down' and 雨 'rain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *hjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): rain comes down.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàyǔ*
- *Say it: xiàyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ wǒmen bù dǎqiú* — It's raining, so we're not playing ball.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for weather, then the Mandarin for rain, then say *xiàyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does xiàyǔ mean? ("To rain".) Say it once more.

66.6 xuě — snow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for rain, then the Mandarin for to rain.

You'll want to know: xuě

xuě — "snow".

> *xuě hěn dà wǒ de ěrduo hěn lěng* — It's snowing hard and my ears are freezing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuě is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'frozen rain'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuě*
- *Say it: xuě*, once more
- *Say it: xuě hěn dà wǒ de ěrduo hěn lěng* — It's snowing hard and my ears are freezing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for rain, then the Mandarin for to rain, then say *xuě* again

Before you move on

What does xuě mean? ("Snow".) Say it once more.

66.7 fēng — wind

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to rain, then the Mandarin for snow.

You'll want to know: fēng

fēng — "wind".

> *tiānqì bù hǎo fēng hěn dà* — The weather's bad: the wind is strong.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēng is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary quotes an old book calling the wind the messenger of sky and earth.

What you've built

One more word for saying how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēng*
- *Say it: fēng*, once more
- *Say it: tiānqì bù hǎo fēng hěn dà* — The weather's bad: the wind is strong.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to rain, then the Mandarin for snow, then say *fēng* again

Before you move on

What does fēng mean? ("Wind".) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

Animals

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name horses, dogs, cats, birds and fish.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 67: I can name horses, dogs, cats, birds and fish.*

67.1 马 (mǎ) — horse

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for snow, then the Mandarin for wind.

You'll want to know: 马

马 — *mǎ* — "horse".

> 我喜欢白马 *wǒ xǐhuan bái mǎ* — I love white horses.

The new character, in pieces: 马 — a turn, a zigzag that hooks, and a bar along the bottom: the right-hand piece of 吗 and 妈. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

马 (*mǎ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *maeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary explains its old character as the shape of a head, a mane, a tail and four legs.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎ*
- *Say it: mǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan bái mǎ* — I love white horses.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for snow, then the Mandarin for wind, then say *mǎ* again

Before you move on

What does 马 mean? ("Horse".) Say it once more.

67.2 马 — a turn, a zigzag, a base

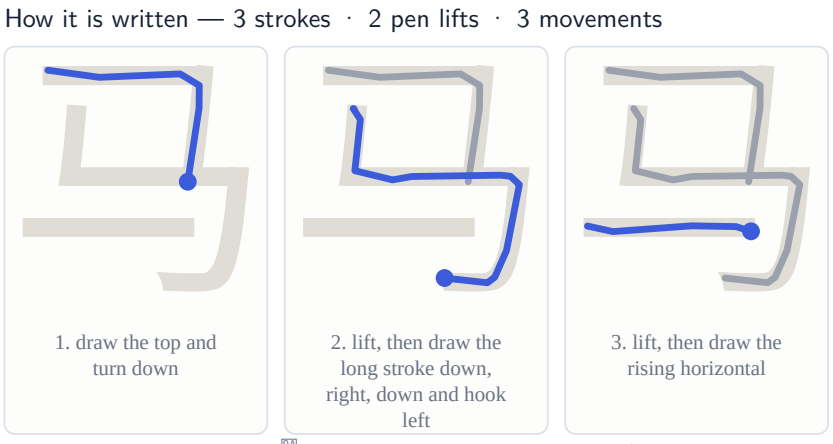
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *mǎ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  吗 妈

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *ma*, *mā*

Script — a turn, a zigzag, a base



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 马.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 马 is written, stroke by stroke

马

One piece, three strokes.

A horizontal that turns down at its right end.

A vertical that turns right, then turns down again and hooks to the left at the foot, all in one stroke.

A horizontal along the bottom, rising a little to the right.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 马, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 马? (**Three.**) Which stroke turns without lifting? (**The second.**) Which characters you know have it on the right? (**吗 and 妈.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 马, pinned stroke paths and medians.

67.3 gǒu — dog

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for wind, then the Mandarin for horse.

You'll want to know: gǒu

gǒu — "dog".

nǐ xǐhuan gǒu ma — Do you like dogs?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǒu is inherited from Middle Chinese *kuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'dog'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǒu*
- *Say it: gǒu*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐhuan gǒu ma* — Do you like dogs?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for wind, then the Mandarin for horse, then say *gǒu* again

Before you move on

What does gǒu mean? ("Dog".) Say it once more.

67.4 māo — cat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for horse, then the Mandarin for dog.

You'll want to know: māo

māo — "cat".

wǒ jiā yǒu māo — We've got a cat at home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

māo is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the animal that catches mice', though māo is not the sound *mjew* would regularly give.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: māo*
- *Say it: māo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā yǒu māo* — We've got a cat at home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for horse, then the Mandarin for dog, then say *māo* again

Before you move on

What does māo mean? ("Cat".) Say it once more.

67.5 niǎo — bird

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dog, then the Mandarin for cat.

You'll want to know: niǎo

niǎo — "bird".

wǒ xǐhuan kàn niǎo — I love watching birds.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *tewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed, through an older book, as the name for all long-tailed birds. Why the modern word begins with n is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: niǎo*
- *Say it: niǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan kàn niǎo* — I love watching birds.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dog, then the Mandarin for cat, then say *niǎo* again

Before you move on

What does niǎo mean? ("Bird".) Say it once more.

67.6 yú — fish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cat, then the Mandarin for bird.

You'll want to know: yú

yú — "fish".

wǒ xǐhuan chī yú — I love eating fish.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yú is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed, through an older book, as a water creature.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: yú*
- *Say it: yú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan chī yú* — I love eating fish.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cat, then the Mandarin for bird, then say *yú* again

Before you move on

What does yú mean? ("Fish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

Out of Town

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name mountains, stars, grass, flowers and the sun.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 68: I can name mountains, stars, grass, flowers and the sun.*

68.1 山 (shān) — mountain; hill

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bird, then the Mandarin for fish.

You'll want to know: 山

山 — *shān* — "mountain; hill".

> 我喜欢山 *wǒ xǐhuan shān* — I love the mountains.

The new character, in pieces: 山 — three peaks standing on one base. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

山 (*shān*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *srean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary quotes an old book saying the mountain brings forth all things.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: shān*
- *Say it: shān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan shān* — I love the mountains.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bird, then the Mandarin for fish, then say *shān* again

Before you move on

What does 山 mean? ("Mountain; hill".) Say it once more.

68.2 山 — three peaks on a base

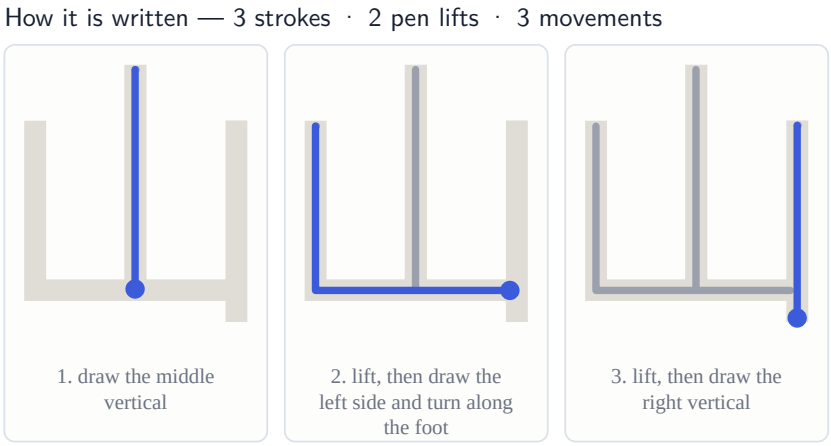
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

岁 中

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *suì*, *zhōng*

Script — three peaks on a base



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 山.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 山 is written, stroke by stroke

山

One piece, three strokes, the middle first.
The tall vertical in the middle.
A vertical down the left that turns and runs right along the bottom.
A vertical down the right, standing on the base.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 山, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 山? (**Three**.) Which stroke comes first? (**The middle one**.) Which character you know has it on top? (岁.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 山, pinned stroke paths and medians.

68.3 星星 (xīngxing) — star

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fish, then the Mandarin for mountain.

You'll want to know: 星星

星星 — *xīngxing* — "star".

天气很好晚上有星星 *tiānqì hěn hǎo wǎnshang yǒu xīngxing* — Fine weather: there'll be stars tonight.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

星星 (*xīngxing*) is built from 星 'star' said twice, the second time light. 星 is inherited from Middle Chinese *seng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīngxing*
- *Say it: xīngxing*, once more
- *Say it: tiānqì hěn hǎo wǎnshang yǒu xīngxing* — Fine weather: there'll be stars tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fish, then the Mandarin for mountain, then say *xīngxing* again

Before you move on

What does 星星 mean? ("Star".) Say it once more.

68.4 cǎo — grass

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for mountain, then the Mandarin for star.

You'll want to know: cǎo

cǎo — "grass".

zhèr de cǎo hěn gāo — The grass here is tall.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed, through an older book, as all the plants that grow.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: cǎo*
- *Say it: cǎo*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de cǎo hěn gāo* — The grass here is tall.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for mountain, then the Mandarin for star, then say *cǎo* again

Before you move on

What does cǎo mean? ("Grass".) Say it once more.

68.5 huā — flower

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for star, then the Mandarin for grass.

You'll want to know: huā

huā — "flower".

māma xǐhuan huā — Mum loves flowers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huā is inherited from Middle Chinese *xwae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary notes as the everyday form, in common use, of an older word for blossom.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: huā*
- *Say it: huā*, once more
- *Say it: māma xǐhuan huā* — Mum loves flowers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for star, then the Mandarin for grass, then say *huā* again

Before you move on

What does huā mean? ("Flower".) Say it once more.

68.6 tàiyang — sun

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grass, then the Mandarin for flower.

You'll want to know: tàiyang

tàiyang — "sun".

jīntiān de tàiyang hěn dà — The sun is strong today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tàiyang is built from tài 'great' and yang, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thajH* and *yang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second as the yang of yin and yang, 'high and

bright': the great bright one.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: tàiyang*
- *Say it: tàiyang*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de tàiyang hěn dà* — The sun is strong today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grass, then the Mandarin for flower, then say *tàiyang* again

Before you move on

What does tàiyang mean? ("Sun".) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Meals

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the meals of the day, say who cooks and say it tastes good.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 69: I can name the meals of the day, say who cooks and say it tastes good.*

69.1 做饭 (zuòfàn) — to cook

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for flower, then the Mandarin for the sun.

You'll want to know: 做饭

做饭 — *zuòfàn* — "to cook".

> 我妈妈喜欢做饭 *wǒ māma xǐhuan zuòfàn* — My mum loves cooking.

The new character, in pieces: 做 — 亻 on the left, 十 over 口 in the middle, and on the right a four-stroke piece like a hand striking. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

做饭 (*zuòfàn*) is built from 做 'to do, to make' and 饭 'meal'. 饭 is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription); 做 has no reading in any dictionary we use, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòfàn*
- *Say it: zuòfàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma xǐhuan zuòfàn* — My mum loves cooking.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for flower, then the Mandarin for the sun, then say *zuòfàn* again

Before you move on

What does 做饭 mean? ("To cook".) Say it once more.

69.2 做 — the person, gǔ, and a striking hand

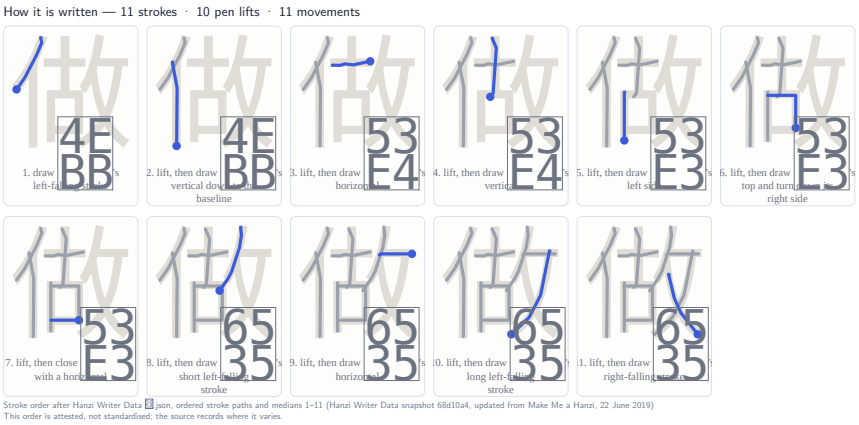
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zuòfàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  他 十 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tā*, *shí*, *kǒu*

Script — the person, gǔ, and a striking hand



How 做 *is written, stroke by stroke*

做

Three pieces, left to right. Count three, not eleven.

亻**, two strokes**, as in 你 and 他.

The middle piece, five strokes, read gǔ: 十, a horizontal and a vertical, standing on a small 口.

The right piece, four strokes: a short left-falling stroke, a short horizontal, a long left-falling stroke, and a long stroke falling to the right.

2 + 5 + 4 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 做, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 做? (**Three.**) What sits in the middle? (**十 on 口.**) How does it end? (**With a stroke falling to the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 做, pinned stroke paths and medians.

69.3 早饭 (zǎofàn) — breakfast

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the sun, then the Mandarin for to cook.

You'll want to know: 早饭

早饭 — *zǎofàn* — "breakfast".

我七点吃早饭 *wǒ qī diǎn chī zǎofàn* — I have breakfast at seven.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

早饭 (*zǎofàn*) is built from zǎo 'morning' and 饭 'meal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsawX* and *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǎofàn*
- *Say it: zǎofàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qī diǎn chī zǎofàn* — I have breakfast at seven.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the sun, then the Mandarin for to cook, then say *zǎofàn* again

Before you move on

What does 早饭 mean? ("Breakfast".) Say it once more.

69.4 午饭 (wǔfàn) — lunch

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to cook, then the Mandarin for breakfast.

You'll want to know: 午饭

午饭 — *wǔfàn* — "lunch".

你吃午饭了吗 *nǐ chī wǔfàn le ma* — Have you had lunch?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

午饭 (*wǔfàn*) is built from 午 'noon' and 饭 'meal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nguX* and *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǔfàn*
- *Say it: wǔfàn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ chī wǔfàn le ma* — Have you had lunch?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to cook, then the Mandarin for breakfast, then say *wǔfàn* again

Before you move on

What does 午饭 mean? ("Lunch".) Say it once more.

69.5 晚饭 (wǎnfàn) — dinner; supper

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for breakfast, then the Mandarin for lunch.

You'll want to know: 晚饭

晚饭 — *wǎnfàn* — "dinner; supper".

今天晚饭吃什么 *jīntiān wǎnfàn chī shénme* — What's for dinner tonight?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

晚饭 (*wǎnfàn*) is built from wǎn 'evening' and 饭 'meal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonX* and *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎnfàn*
- *Say it: wǎnfàn*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǎnfàn chī shénme* — What's for dinner tonight?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for breakfast, then the Mandarin for lunch, then say *wǎnfàn* again

Before you move on

What does 晚饭 mean? ("Dinner; supper".) Say it once more.

69.6 好吃 (hǎochī) — tasty; good to eat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lunch, then the Mandarin for dinner.

You'll want to know: 好吃

好吃 — *hǎochī* — "tasty; good to eat".

我妈妈做饭很好吃 *wǒ māma zuòfàn hěn hǎochī* — My mum's cooking is delicious.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好吃 (*hǎochī*) is built from 好 'good' and 吃 'to eat': good to eat. 好 is inherited from Middle Chinese *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); 吃 is probably the *khek* the dictionary writes with

another character and glosses 'to eat', though chī is not the sound *khek* would regularly give.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎochī*
- *Say it: hǎochī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma zuòfàn hěn hǎochī* — My mum's cooking is delicious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lunch, then the Mandarin for dinner, then say *hǎochī* again

Before you move on

What does 好吃 mean? ("Tasty; good to eat".) Say it once more.

69.7 Looking back: from Asking for Help to Meals

Say the Mandarin for sorry and to help.

Your turn

- *Say it:* sorry, to help, to do a favour, to borrow, to give back
- *Say it:* door, may I ask, excuse me, to open, to shut
- *Say it:* weather, rain, to rain, snow, wind
- *Say it:* horse, dog, cat, bird, fish
- *Say it:* mountain, star, grass, flower, the sun
- *Say it:* to cook, breakfast, lunch, dinner, tasty
- *Read it:* 起 门 问 气 雨 马 山 做 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Sorry? (对不起, *duìbuqǐ.*) To help? (*bāng.*) To do a favour? (*bāngmáng.*) To borrow? (*jiè.*) To give back? (*huán.*) Door? (门, *mén.*) May I ask? (请问, *qǐngwèn.*) Excuse me? (*bù hǎoyìsi.*) To open? (*kāi.*) To shut? (*guān.*) Weather? (天气, *tiānqì.*) Rain? (雨, *yǔ.*) To rain? (*xiàyǔ.*) Snow? (*xuě.*) Wind? (*fēng.*) Horse? (马, *mǎ.*) Dog? (*gǒu.*) Cat? (*māo.*) Bird? (*niǎo.*) Fish? (*yú.*) Mountain? (山, *shān.*) Star? (星星, *xīngxing.*) Grass? (*cǎo.*) Flower? (*huā.*) The sun? (*tàiyang.*) To cook? (做饭, *zuòfàn.*) Breakfast? (早饭, *zǎofàn.*) Lunch? (午饭, *wǔfàn.*) Dinner? (晚饭, *wǎnfàn.*) Tasty? (好吃, *hǎochī.*)

Chapter 70

More to Eat

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name meat, buns, noodles, dumplings and soup.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 70: I can name meat, buns, noodles, dumplings and soup.*

70.1 ròu — meat

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dinner, then the Mandarin for tasty.

You'll want to know: ròu

ròu — "meat".

> *wǒ bù chī ròu* — I don't eat meat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ròu is inherited from Middle Chinese *nyuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed with the pair 'bone and flesh'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: ròu*
- *Say it: ròu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù chī ròu* — I don't eat meat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dinner, then the Mandarin for tasty, then say *ròu* again

Before you move on

What does ròu mean? ("Meat".) Say it once more.

70.2 bāozi — steamed bun

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tasty, then the Mandarin for meat.

You'll want to know: bāozi

bāozi — "steamed bun".

wǒ chī le sān ge bāozi — I ate three buns.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bāozi is built from bāo 'to wrap', the same bāo as the word for bag, and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *paew* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a filling wrapped in dough.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāozi*
- *Say it: bāozi*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ chī le sān ge bāozi* — I ate three buns.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tasty, then the Mandarin for meat, then say *bāozi* again

Before you move on

What does bāozi mean? ("Steamed bun".) Say it once more.

70.3 miàntiáo — noodles

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for meat, then the Mandarin for steamed bun.

You'll want to know: miàntiáo

miàntiáo — "noodles".

wǒ xǐhuan chī miàntiáo — I love noodles.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

miàntiáo is built from miàn 'flour' and tiáo 'a twig, a strip', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *menH* and *dew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): strips of flour.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: miàntiáo*
- *Say it: miàntiáo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan chī miàntiáo* — I love noodles.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for meat, then the Mandarin for steamed bun, then say *miàntiáo* again

Before you move on

What does miàntiáo mean? (“Noodles”.) Say it once more.

70.4 jiǎozi — dumpling

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for steamed bun, then the Mandarin for noodles.

You’ll want to know: jiǎozi

jiǎozi — “dumpling”.

xīngqītiān wǒmen chī jiǎozi — We have dumplings on Sunday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎozi is built from jiǎo and the noun ending zi, which is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription). The first has no reading in any dictionary we use, so its history is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎozi*
- *Say it: jiǎozi*, once more
- *Say it: xīngqītiān wǒmen chī jiǎozi* — We have dumplings on Sunday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for steamed bun, then the Mandarin for noodles, then say *jiǎozi* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎozi mean? (“Dumpling”.) Say it once more.

70.5 tāng — soup

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for noodles, then the Mandarin for dumpling.

You'll want to know: tāng

tāng — "soup".

nǐ hē tāng ma — Would you like some soup?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tāng is inherited from Middle Chinese *thang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'hot water'. Soup is not given there; from hot water to soup is the likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāng*
- *Say it: tāng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ hē tāng ma* — Would you like some soup?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for noodles, then the Mandarin for dumpling, then say *tāng* again

Before you move on

What does tāng mean? ("Soup".) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

Tastes

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a drink is nice, food is sweet, hot or salty, and order a meal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 71: I can say a drink is nice, food is sweet, hot or salty, and order a meal.*

71.1 好喝 (hǎohē) — nice to drink

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dumpling, then the Mandarin for soup.

You'll want to know: 好喝

好喝 — *hǎohē* — "nice to drink".

> *zhèr de chá hěn hǎohē* — The tea here is lovely.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好喝 (*hǎohē*) is built from 好 'good' and 喝 'to drink', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *xat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as 'to shout at', and the drinking sense is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎohē*
- *Say it: hǎohē*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de chá hěn hǎohē* — The tea here is lovely.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dumpling, then the Mandarin for soup, then say *hǎohē* again

Before you move on

What does 好喝 mean? ("Nice to drink".) Say it once more.

71.2 tián — sweet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for soup, then the Mandarin for nice to drink.

You'll want to know: tián

tián — "sweet".

nǐ de kāfēi hěn tián — Your coffee is very sweet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tián is inherited from Middle Chinese *dem* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'sweet'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: tián*
- *Say it: tián*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ de kāfēi hěn tián* — Your coffee is very sweet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for soup, then the Mandarin for nice to drink, then say *tián* again

Before you move on

What does tián mean? ("Sweet".) Say it once more.

71.3 là — spicy; hot

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for nice to drink, then the Mandarin for sweet.

You'll want to know: là

là — "spicy; hot".

zhèr de cài hěn là — The food here is really spicy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

là is inherited from Middle Chinese *lat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'pungent'; the dictionary writes it with a variant form of the character.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: là*
- *Say it: là*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de cài hěn là* — The food here is really spicy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for nice to drink, then the Mandarin for sweet, then say *là* again

Before you move on

What does là mean? (“Spicy; hot”.) Say it once more.

71.4 xián — salty

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sweet, then the Mandarin for spicy.

You’ll want to know: xián

xián — “salty”.

jīntiān de tāng hěn xián — Today’s soup is salty.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xián is inherited from Middle Chinese *heam* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’not bland’; the dictionary writes it with the traditional form of the character.

What you’ve built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: xián*
- *Say it: xián*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de tāng hěn xián* — Today’s soup is salty.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sweet, then the Mandarin for spicy, then say *xián* again

Before you move on

What does xián mean? (“Salty”.) Say it once more.

71.5 diǎncài — to order food

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for spicy, then the Mandarin for salty.

You'll want to know: diǎncài

diǎncài — "to order food".

wǒ xiǎng diǎncài — I'd like to order.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diǎncài is built from 点 'a dot, to mark' and cài 'dish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *temX* and *tshojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as any plant fit to eat. Marking the dishes you want is the likely picture, but the step is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: diǎncài*
- *Say it: diǎncài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng diǎncài* — I'd like to order.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for spicy, then the Mandarin for salty, then say *diǎncài* again

Before you move on

What does diǎncài mean? ("To order food".) Say it once more.

Chapter 72

Getting About

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about trains, driving, planes, roads and arriving.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 72: I can talk about trains, driving, planes, roads and arriving.*

72.1 火车 (huǒchē) — train

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for salty, then the Mandarin for to order food.

You'll want to know: 火车

火车 — *huǒchē* — "train".

> 这儿的火车很长 *zhèr de huǒchē hěn cháng* — The trains here are long.

The new character, in pieces: 火 — a dot on each side, and 人 between them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

火车 (*huǒchē*) is built from 火 'fire' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwaX* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription): a fire carriage, from the days of steam.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: huǒchē*
- *Say it: huǒchē*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de huǒchē hěn cháng* — The trains here are long.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for salty, then the Mandarin for to order food, then say *huǒchē* again

Before you move on

What does 火车 mean? ("Train".) Say it once more.

72.2 火 — two sparks around 人

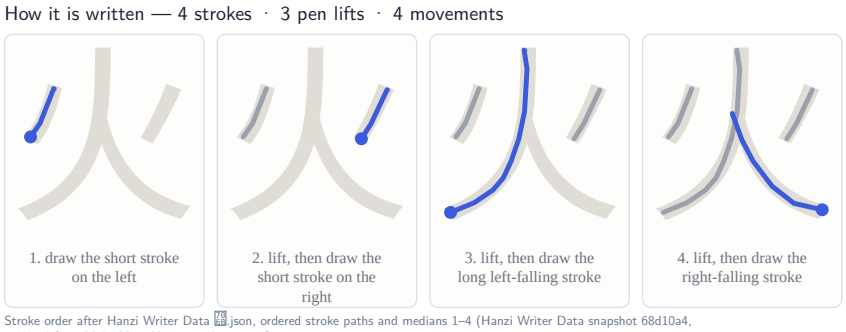
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *huǒchē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

人 大

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *dà*

Script — two sparks around 人



How 火 is written, stroke by stroke

火

One piece, four strokes.

A short dot on the left, slanting down to the right.

A short left-falling stroke on the right, falling toward the middle.

人**, two strokes**: a long left-falling stroke from the top down to the lower left, then a long stroke falling to the right from its middle.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 火, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 火? (**Four**.) Which character you know is its last two strokes? (人.) What comes first? (**The dot on the left**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 火, pinned stroke paths and medians.

72.3 开车 (kāichē) — to drive

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to order food, then the Mandarin for train.

You'll want to know: 开车

开车 — *kāichē* — "to drive".

> 明天我们开车去看山 *míngtiān wǒmen kāichē qù kàn shān* — Tomorrow we're driving out to see the mountains.

The new character, in pieces: 开 — two bars, with two legs down through them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开车 (*kāichē*) is built from 开 'to open' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Driving is not among the senses of the first there; opening up, setting going, is the likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāichē*
- *Say it: kāichē*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǒmen kāichē qù kàn shān* — Tomorrow we're driving out to see the mountains.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to order food, then the Mandarin for train, then say *kāichē* again

Before you move on

What does 开车 mean? ("To drive".) Say it once more.

72.4 开 — two bars, two legs

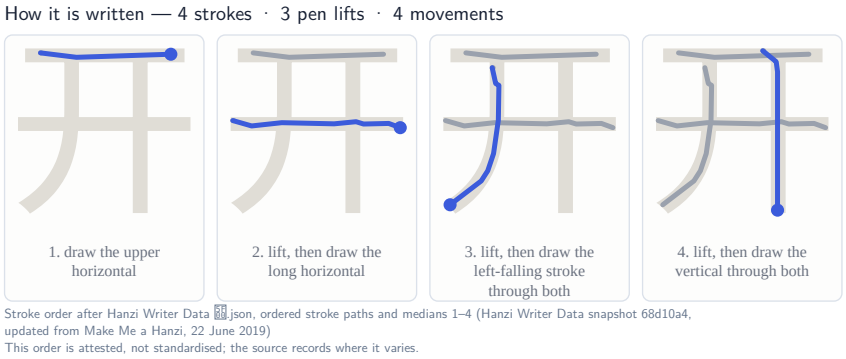
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kāichē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

二 车

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *èr*, *chē*

Script — two bars, two legs



How 开 is written, stroke by stroke

开

One piece, four strokes, the bars first.
A short horizontal on top, then **a long horizontal** below it.
A left-falling stroke from the upper bar, down through the lower one to the bottom left.
A vertical on the right, straight down through both bars.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 开, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 开? (**Four**.) Which come first, the bars or the legs? (**The bars**.) Which leg is straight? (**The right one**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 开, pinned stroke paths and medians.

72.5 fēijī — aeroplane

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for train, then the Mandarin for to drive.

You'll want to know: fēijī

fēijī — "aeroplane".

wǒmen zuò fēijī qù Běijīng — We're flying to Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēijī is built from fēi 'to fly' and 机 'machine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pj+j* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a flying machine.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēijī*
- *Say it: fēijī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò fēijī qù Běijīng* — We're flying to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for train, then the Mandarin for to drive, then say *fēijī* again

Before you move on

What does fēijī mean? ("Aeroplane".) Say it once more.

72.6 lù — road; way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to drive, then the Mandarin for aeroplane.

You'll want to know: lù

lù — "road; way".

lù hěn yuǎn — It's a long way.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lù is inherited from Middle Chinese *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'road'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: lù*
- *Say it: lù*, once more
- *Say it: lù hěn yuǎn* — It's a long way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to drive, then the Mandarin for aeroplane, then say *lù* again

Before you move on

What does lù mean? ("Road; way".) Say it once more.

72.7 dào — to arrive; to reach

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for aeroplane, then the Mandarin for road.

You'll want to know: dào

dào — "to arrive; to reach".

huǒchē hěn màn shí diǎn dào — The train is slow; it gets in at ten.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dào is inherited from Middle Chinese *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to reach'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: dào*
- *Say it: dào*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē hěn màn shí diǎn dào* — The train is slow; it gets in at ten.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for aeroplane, then the Mandarin for road, then say *dào* again

Before you move on

What does dào mean? ("To arrive; to reach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 73

At the Station

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say get on and get off, and name the station, the airport and tickets.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 73: I can say get on and get off, and name the station, the airport and tickets.*

73.1 下车 (xiàchē) — to get off (a bus or train)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for road, then the Mandarin for to arrive.

You'll want to know: 下车

下车 — *xiàchē* — "to get off (a bus or train)".

> 我们下车吃饭 *wǒmen xiàchē chī fàn* — Let's get off and eat.

The new character, in pieces: 下 — a bar, a vertical hanging from it, and a dot to the right: 上 turned over. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

下车 (*xiàchē*) is built from 下 'to go down' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàchē*
- *Say it: xiàchē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiàchē chī fàn* — Let's get off and eat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for road, then the Mandarin for to arrive, then say *xiàchē* again

Before you move on

What does 下车 mean? ("To get off (a bus or train)".) Say it once more.

73.2 下 — a bar, a vertical, a dot

The word first, then the character inside it.

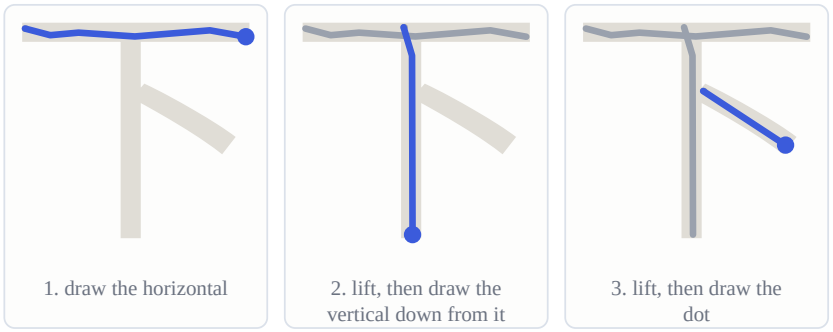
- *Recall:* say *xiàchē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

上 车

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shàng*, *chē*

Script — a bar, a vertical, a dot

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 汉字.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 下 is written, stroke by stroke

下

One piece, three strokes.
A long horizontal across the top.
A vertical hanging down from its middle.
A dot to the right of the vertical, slanting down to the right.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 下, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 下? (**Three.**) Which character you know is it turned over? (上.) Where does the dot go? (**To the right of the vertical.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 下, pinned stroke paths and medians.

73.3 上车 (shàngchē) — to get on (a bus or train)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to arrive, then the Mandarin for to get off.

You'll want to know: 上车

上车 — *shàngchē* — "to get on (a bus or train)".

下雨快上车 *xiàyǔ kuài shàngchē* — It's raining: quick, get in!

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上车 (*shàngchē*) is built from 上 'to go up' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngchē*
- *Say it: shàngchē*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ kuài shàngchē* — It's raining: quick, get in!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to arrive, then the Mandarin for to get off, then say *shàngchē* again

Before you move on

What does 上车 mean? ("To get on (a bus or train)".) Say it once more.

73.4 huǒchēzhàn — railway station

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get off, then the Mandarin for to get on.

You'll want to know: huǒchēzhàn

huǒchēzhàn — "railway station".

> *huǒchēzhàn hěn yuǎn* — The station is a long way off.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huǒchēzhàn is built from 火车 'train' and zhàn 'a stop', inherited from Middle Chinese *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary glosses as the everyday word for standing alone. The sense 'station' is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: huǒchēzhàn*
- *Say it: huǒchēzhàn*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchēzhàn hěn yuǎn* — The station is a long way off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get off, then the Mandarin for to get on, then say *huǒchēzhàn* again

Before you move on

What does huǒchēzhàn mean? ("Railway station".) Say it once more.

73.5 jīchǎng — airport

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get on, then the Mandarin for railway station.

You'll want to know: jīchǎng

jīchǎng — "airport".

> *wǒ qù jīchǎng* — I'm going to the airport.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīchǎng is built from 机 'machine' and chǎng 'open ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kj+j* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as a threshing floor. The machine here is the plane.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīchǎng*
- *Say it: jīchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù jīchǎng* — I'm going to the airport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get on, then the Mandarin for railway station, then say *jīchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does jīchǎng mean? ("Airport".) Say it once more.

73.6 piào — ticket

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for railway station, then the Mandarin for airport.

You'll want to know: piào

piào — "ticket".

wǒ mǎi le piào — I've bought the tickets.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

piào is written with a character the Guangyun records, under an older form, as *phjiew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'flying fire'. That is probably a different word: the ticket sense is not given there, and *phjiew* would regularly give piāo, not piào. How the character came to write the word for ticket is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: piào*
- *Say it: piào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎi le piào* — I've bought the tickets.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for railway station, then the Mandarin for airport, then say *piào* again

Before you move on

What does piào mean? ("Ticket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 74

Visiting

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask a guest in, welcome them and introduce people.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 74: I can ask a guest in, welcome them and introduce people.*

74.1 进 (jìn) — to come in; to enter

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for airport, then the Mandarin for ticket.

You'll want to know: 进

进 — *jìn* — "to come in; to enter".

> 他进门了 *tā jìn mén le* — He's come in at the door.

The new character, in pieces: 进 — a four-stroke piece read jǐng, a well, on the road piece of 这. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

进 (*jìn*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'forward' and 'to advance'.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìn*
- *Say it: jìn*, once more
- *Say it: tā jìn mén le* — He's come in at the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for airport, then the Mandarin for ticket, then say *jìn* again

Before you move on

What does 进 mean? ("To come in; to enter".) Say it once more.

74.2 进 — jǐng on the road piece

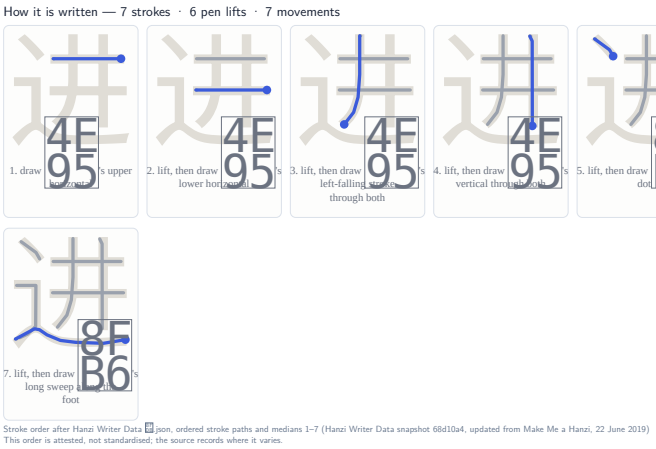
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jìn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  开 这

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kāi*, *zhè*

Script — jǐng on the road piece



How 进 *is written, stroke by stroke*

进

Two pieces: jǐng first, the road last, though the road runs up the left and under.

Jǐng, four strokes: two horizontals, then a left-falling stroke and a vertical down through them, the same four as 开.

The road piece, three strokes, as in 这: a dot, then a stroke that turns and turns again, then a long sweep along the bottom to the right.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 进, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 进? (**Two**.) Which character you know has the same first four strokes? (开.) Which character has the same road piece? (这.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 进, pinned stroke paths and medians.

74.3 客人 (kèrén) — guest

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ticket, then the Mandarin for to come in.

You'll want to know: 客人

客人 — *kèrén* — "guest".

客人来了快开门 *kèrén lái le kuài kāi mén* — The guests are here: quick, open the door!

The new character, in pieces: 客 — the roof of 家, a walking foot under it, and 口 at the bottom. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

客人 (*kèrén*) is built from 客 'guest' and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaek* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: kèrén*
- *Say it: kèrén*, once more
- *Say it: kèrén lái le kuài kāi mén* — The guests are here: quick, open the door!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ticket, then the Mandarin for to come in, then say *kèrén* again

Before you move on

What does 客人 mean? ("Guest".) Say it once more.

74.4 客 — under the roof, a foot and 口

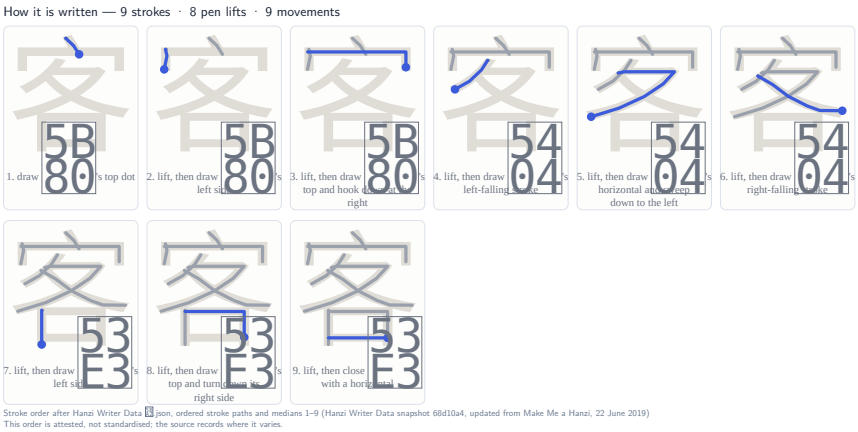
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kèrén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

家 字 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jiā*, *zì*, *kǒu*

Script — under the roof, a foot and 口



How 客 *is written, stroke by stroke*

客

Three pieces, top to bottom.

The roof, three strokes, as on 家 and 字: a dot, a short stroke down the left, and a horizontal that turns down and hooks.

The walking foot, three strokes: a short left-falling stroke, a horizontal that turns into a long left-falling stroke, and a long stroke falling to the right.

口, three strokes, at the bottom.

3 + 3 + 3 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 客, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 客? (**Three**.) Which characters you know have the same roof? (家 **and** 字.) What sits at the bottom? (口.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 客, pinned stroke paths and medians.

74.5 门口 (ménkǒu) — doorway; entrance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come in, then the Mandarin for guest.

You'll want to know: 门口

门口 — *ménkǒu* — "doorway; entrance".

门口有一个客人 *ménkǒu yǒu yí ge kèrén* — There's a guest at the door.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

门口 (*ménkǒu*) is built from 门 'door' and 口 'mouth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mwon* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the mouth of the door, where you go in.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: ménkǒu*
- *Say it: ménkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: ménkǒu yǒu yí ge kèrén* — There's a guest at the door.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come in, then the Mandarin for guest, then say *ménkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 门口 mean? ("Doorway; entrance".) Say it once more.

74.6 huānyíng — welcome

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for guest, then the Mandarin for doorway.

You'll want to know: huānyíng

huānyíng — "welcome".

huānyíng nǐ lái wǒ jiā — Welcome to my home!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huānyíng is built from huān 'glad' and yíng 'to go to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwan* and *ngjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): glad to meet you.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: huānyíng*
- *Say it: huānyíng*, once more
- *Say it: huānyíng nǐ lái wǒ jiā* — Welcome to my home!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for guest, then the Mandarin for doorway, then say *huānyíng* again

Before you move on

What does huānyíng mean? (“Welcome”.) Say it once more.

74.7 jièshào — to introduce

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for doorway, then the Mandarin for welcome.

You’ll want to know: jièshào

jièshào — “to introduce”.

qǐng nǐ jièshào nǐ de jiārén — Tell us about your family, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jièshào is built from jiè and shào, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keajH* and *dzyewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as ’to help’ and the second as ’to carry on’; how the pair came to mean introducing somebody is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: jièshào*
- *Say it: jièshào*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng nǐ jièshào nǐ de jiārén* — Tell us about your family, please.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for doorway, then the Mandarin for welcome, then say *jièshào* again

Before you move on

What does jièshào mean? (“To introduce”.) Say it once more.

74.8 Looking back: from More to Eat to Visiting

Say the Mandarin for meat and steamed bun.

Your turn

- *Say it:* meat, steamed bun, noodles, dumpling, soup
- *Say it:* nice to drink, sweet, spicy, salty, to order food
- *Say it:* train, to drive, aeroplane, road, to arrive
- *Say it:* to get off, to get on, railway station, airport, ticket
- *Say it:* to come in, guest, doorway, welcome, to introduce
- *Read it:* 火 开 下 进 客 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Meat? (*ròu.*) Steamed bun? (*bāozi.*) Noodles? (*miàntiáo.*) Dumpling? (*jiǎozi.*) Soup? (*tāng.*) Nice to drink? (好喝, *hǎohē.*) Sweet? (*tián.*) Spicy? (*là.*) Salty? (*xián.*) To order food? (*diǎncài.*) Train? (火车, *huǒchē.*) To drive? (开车, *kāichē.*) Aeroplane? (*fēijī.*) Road? (*lù.*) To arrive? (*dào.*) To get off? (下车, *xiàchē.*) To get on? (上车, *shàngchē.*) Railway station? (*huǒchēzhàn.*) Airport? (*jīchǎng.*) Ticket? (*piào.*) To come in? (进, *jìn.*) Guest? (客人, *kèrén.*) Doorway? (门口, *ménkǒu.*) Welcome? (*huānyíng.*) To introduce? (*jièshào.*)

Chapter 75

Celebrating

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can wish somebody a happy birthday and give a present.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 75: I can wish somebody a happy birthday and give a present.*

75.1 快乐 (kuàilè) — joyful; happy

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for welcome, then the Mandarin for to introduce.

You'll want to know: 快乐

快乐 — *kuàilè* — "joyful; happy".

> 我们很快乐 *wǒmen hěn kuàilè* — We're very happy.

The new character, in pieces: 乐 — a nearly flat fall, a turn, and then 小 with its middle hooked. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

快乐 (*kuàilè*) is built from 快 and 乐, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khwaejH* and *lak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as 'glad' and the second as 'joy': gladness twice over.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuàilè*
- *Say it: kuàilè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen hěn kuàilè* — We're very happy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for welcome, then the Mandarin for to introduce, then say *kuàilè* again

Before you move on

What does 快乐 mean? ("Joyful; happy".) Say it once more.

75.2 乐 — a fall, a turn, and 小

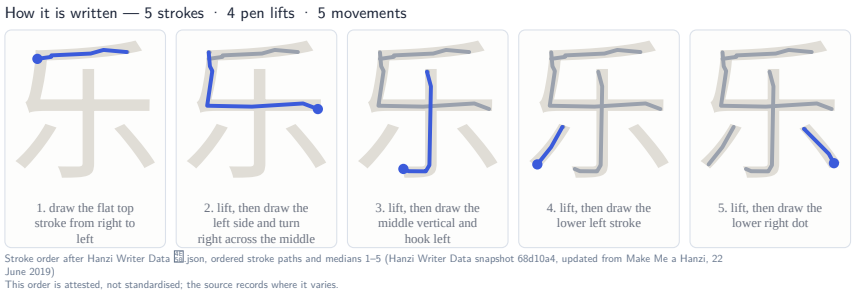
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kuàilè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

小 快

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xiǎo*, *kuài*

Script — a fall, a turn, and 小



How 乐 is written, stroke by stroke

乐

One piece, five strokes.
A left-falling stroke across the top, from right to left, nearly flat.
A vertical that turns right, under the left end of the first stroke.
Then the three strokes of 小: the vertical down the middle that hooks to the left, a dot falling left, a dot falling right.
2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 乐, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 乐? (**Five**.) Which character you know are its last three? (小.) Which way does the first stroke run? (**From right to left, nearly flat**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 乐, pinned stroke paths and medians.

75.3 生日 (shēngrì) — birthday

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to introduce, then the Mandarin for joyful.

You'll want to know: 生日

生日 — *shēngrì* — "birthday".

明天是我的生日 *míngtiān shì wǒ de shēngrì* — Tomorrow is my birthday.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生日 (*shēngrì*) is built from 生 'to be born' and 日 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *nyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngrì*
- *Say it: shēngrì*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān shì wǒ de shēngrì* — Tomorrow is my birthday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to introduce, then the Mandarin for joyful, then say *shēngrì* again

Before you move on

What does 生日 mean? ("Birthday".) Say it once more.

75.4 dàngāo — cake

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for joyful, then the Mandarin for birthday.

You'll want to know: dàngāo

dàngāo — "cake".

māma de dàngāo hěn hǎochī — Mum's cake is delicious.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàngāo is built from dàn 'egg', the dàn of jīdàn, and gāo 'cake'. No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled; the second is probably the *kaw* that the Guangyun writes with another form of the character (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed with a word for gruel.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàngāo*
- *Say it: dàngāo*, once more
- *Say it: māma de dàngāo hěn hǎochī* — Mum's cake is delicious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for joyful, then the Mandarin for birthday, then say *dàngāo* again

Before you move on

What does dàngāo mean? ("Cake".) Say it once more.

75.5 lǐwù — present; gift

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for birthday, then the Mandarin for cake.

You'll want to know: lǐwù

lǐwù — "present; gift".

wǒ mǎi le yí ge lǐwù — I've bought a present.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǐwù is built from lǐ 'rite, courtesy' and wù 'thing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lejX* and *mjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a thing given out of courtesy.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐwù*
- *Say it: lǐwù*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ mǎi le yí ge lǐwù* — I've bought a present.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for birthday, then the Mandarin for cake, then say *lǐwù* again

Before you move on

What does lǐwù mean? ("Present; gift".) Say it once more.

75.6 sòng — to give as a present; to see off

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cake, then the Mandarin for present.

You'll want to know: sòng

sòng — "to give as a present; to see off".

wǒmen sòng shénme lǐwù — What present shall we give?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sòng is inherited from Middle Chinese *suwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to send off'; giving a present is sending something off with somebody.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: sòng*
- *Say it: sòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen sòng shénme lǐwù* — What present shall we give?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cake, then the Mandarin for present, then say *sòng* again

Before you move on

What does sòng mean? (“To give as a present; to see off”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 76

Parting

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say see you soon, see you tomorrow, good night and bye-bye.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 76: I can say see you soon, see you tomorrow, good night and bye-bye.*

76.1 一会儿 (yíhuìr) — a little while; in a moment

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for present, then the Mandarin for to give as a present.

You'll want to know: 一会儿

一会儿 — *yíhuìr* — "a little while; in a moment".

> 我一会儿打电话 *wǒ yíhuìr dǎ diànhuà* — I'll ring in a little while.

The new character, in pieces: 会 — 人 spread as a roof, two bars, and a bend with a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

yī changes its tone here, rising to yí before the falling huì: yíhuìr.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一会儿 (*yíhuìr*) is built from 一 'one', huì and the ending r, inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit*, *hwajH* and *nye* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses huì as 'to come together'; how

the phrase came to mean a short while is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíhuìr*
- *Say it: yíhuìr*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yíhuìr dǎ diànhuà* — I'll ring in a little while.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for present, then the Mandarin for to give as a present, then say *yíhuìr* again

Before you move on

What does 一会儿 mean? ("A little while; in a moment".) Say it once more.

76.2 会 — 人 over two bars and a bend

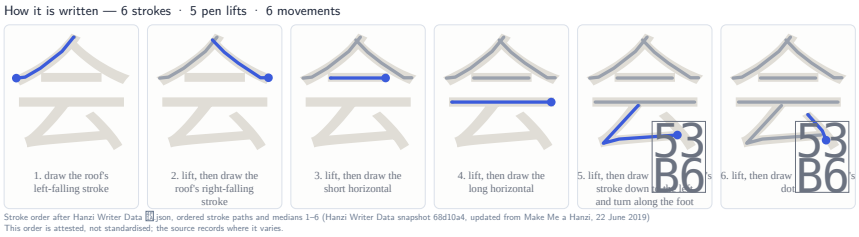
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yíhuìr* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

人 今 去

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *jīn*, *qù*

Script — 人 over two bars and a bend



How 会 is written, stroke by stroke

会

Three parts, top to bottom.
人, two strokes, spread wide as a roof, as on 今.
Two horizontals under it, the lower one longer.
A stroke that falls left and turns right along the bottom, then **a dot**: the same two strokes that end 去.
2 + 2 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 会, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 会? (**Six**.) Which character you know is on top? (人.) What comes last? (**A dot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 会, pinned stroke paths and medians.

76.3 明天见 (míngtiān jiàn) — see you tomorrow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give as a present, then the Mandarin for a little while.

You'll want to know: 明天见

明天见 — *míngtiān jiàn* — "see you tomorrow".

下雨我们明天见 *xiàyǔ wǒmen míngtiān jiàn* — It's raining: let's meet tomorrow.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

明天见 (*míngtiān jiàn*) is built from 明天 'tomorrow' and 见 'to see', the 见 of 再见.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngtiān jiàn*
- *Say it: míngtiān jiàn*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ wǒmen míngtiān jiàn* — It's raining: let's meet tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give as a present, then the Mandarin for a little while, then say *míngtiān jiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 明天见 mean? ("See you tomorrow".) Say it once more.

76.4 再说 (zàishuō) — to leave it till later

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a little while, then the Mandarin for see you tomorrow.

You'll want to know: 再说

再说 — *zàishuō* — "to leave it till later".

对不起一会儿再说 *duìbuqǐ yíhuìr zàishuō* — Sorry: let's talk about it in a bit.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

再说 (*zàishuō*) is built from 再 'again' and 说 'to say', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsojH* and *sywet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): say it again, another time.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: zàishuō*
- *Say it: zàishuō*, once more
- *Say it: duìbuqǐ yíhuìr zàishuō* — Sorry: let's talk about it in a bit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a little while, then the Mandarin for see you tomorrow, then say *zàishuō* again

Before you move on

What does 再说 mean? ("To leave it till later".) Say it once more.

76.5 wǎn'ān — good night

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for see you tomorrow, then the Mandarin for to leave it till later.

You'll want to know: wǎn'ān

wǎn'ān — "good night".

māma wǎn'ān — Mum, good night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǎn'ān is built from wǎn 'evening' and ān 'peace', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonX* and *'an* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as 'calm, at rest'.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎn'ān*
- *Say it: wǎn'ān*, once more

- *Say it: māma wǎn'ān* — Mum, good night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for see you tomorrow, then the Mandarin for to leave it till later, then say *wǎn'ān* again

Before you move on

What does wǎn'ān mean? ("Good night".) Say it once more.

76.6 bàibai — bye-bye

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leave it till later, then the Mandarin for good night.

You'll want to know: bàibai

bàibai — "bye-bye".

bàibai míngtiān jiàn — Bye, see you tomorrow!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàibai is borrowed from English *bye-bye*, written with a character read bài, 'to bow', for the sound.

What you've built

One more word for times and partings.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàibai*
- *Say it: bàibai*, once more
- *Say it: bàibai míngtiān jiàn* — Bye, see you tomorrow!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leave it till later, then the Mandarin for good night, then say *bàibai* again

Before you move on

What does bàibai mean? (“Bye-bye”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 77

Thanks and Replies

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer thanks, thank people warmly and say really and very.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 77: I can answer thanks, thank people warmly and say really and very.*

77.1 不客气 (bú kèqi) — you're welcome; don't mention it

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for good night, then the Mandarin for bye-bye.

You'll want to know: 不客气

不客气 — *bú kèqi* — "you're welcome; don't mention it".

> 不客气请进 *bú kèqi qǐng jìn* — Don't mention it. Do come in!

bù changes its tone here, rising to bú before the falling kè: bú kèqi.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不客气 (*bú kèqi*) is built from 不 'not' and kèqi 'polite, formal', from Middle Chinese *khaek* 'guest' and *khj+jH* 'breath' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): no need to be formal.

What you've built

One more word for thanking and answering thanks.

Your turn

- *Say it: bú kèqi*
- *Say it: bú kèqi*, once more
- *Say it: bú kèqi qǐng jìn* — Don't mention it. Do come in!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for good night, then the Mandarin for bye-bye, then say *bú kèqi* again

Before you move on

What does 不客气 mean? ("You're welcome; don't mention it".) Say it once more.

77.2 máfan — to trouble; to bother

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bye-bye, then the Mandarin for don't mention it.

You'll want to know: máfan

máfan — "to trouble; to bother".

bù hǎoyìsi máfan nǐ — Sorry to trouble you.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

máfan is built from má and fán, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mae* and *bjon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as hemp and the second as 'toil'; how the pair came to mean putting somebody to trouble is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for thanking and answering thanks.

Your turn

- *Say it: máfan*
- *Say it: máfan*, once more
- *Say it: bù hǎoyìsi máfan nǐ* — Sorry to trouble you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bye-bye, then the Mandarin for don't mention it, then say *máfan* again

Before you move on

What does máfan mean? ("To trouble; to bother".) Say it once more.

77.3 gǎnxiè — to thank (warmly)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for don't mention it, then the Mandarin for to trouble somebody.

You'll want to know: gǎnxiè

gǎnxiè — "to thank (warmly)".

gǎnxiè dàjiā — Thank you, everyone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎnxiè is built from gǎn 'to be moved' and 谢 'to thank', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *zjaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for thanking and answering thanks.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnxiè*
- *Say it: gǎnxiè*, once more
- *Say it: gǎnxiè dàjiā* — Thank you, everyone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for don't mention it, then the Mandarin for to trouble somebody, then say *gǎnxiè* again

Before you move on

What does gǎnxiè mean? ("To thank (warmly)".) Say it once more.

77.4 fēicháng — extremely; very

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to trouble somebody, then the Mandarin for to thank.

You'll want to know: fēicháng

fēicháng — "extremely; very".

fēicháng gǎnxiè — Thank you so much.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēicháng is built from fēi 'not' and cháng, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pj+j* and *dzyang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as 'it is not so'; the second as 'usual' is not given there, so 'out of the ordinary' is likely but not settled.

What you've built

One more word for thanking and answering thanks.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēicháng*
- *Say it: fēicháng*, once more
- *Say it: fēicháng gǎnxiè* — Thank you so much.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to trouble somebody, then the Mandarin for to thank, then say *fēicháng* again

Before you move on

What does fēicháng mean? ("Extremely; very".) Say it once more.

77.5 zhēn — really; truly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to thank, then the Mandarin for extremely.

You'll want to know: zhēn

zhēn — "really; truly".

nǐ zhēn hǎo — You're so kind.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhēn is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'true, as against false'.

What you've built

One more word for thanking and answering thanks.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhēn*
- *Say it: zhēn*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ zhēn hǎo* — You're so kind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to thank, then the Mandarin for extremely, then say *zhēn* again

Before you move on

What does zhēn mean? ("Really; truly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 78

Age and Growing Up

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how old somebody is and talk about growing up and years ago.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 78: I can ask how old somebody is and talk about growing up and years ago.*

78.1 多大 (duō dà) — how old (asking a person's age)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for extremely, then the Mandarin for really.

You'll want to know: 多大

多大 — *duō dà* — "how old (asking a person's age)".

> 生日快乐你今年多大 *shēngrì kuàilè nǐ jīnnián duō dà* — Happy birthday! How old are you now?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

多大 (*duō dà*) is built from 多 'much' and 大 'big': how big, said of a person's years.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: duō dà*
- *Say it: duō dà*, once more
- *Say it: shēngrì kuàilè nǐ jīnnián duō dà* — Happy birthday! How old are you now?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for extremely, then the Mandarin for really, then say *duō dà* again

Before you move on

What does 多大 mean? ("How old (asking a person's age)".) Say it once more.

78.2 长大 (zhǎngdà) — to grow up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for really, then the Mandarin for how old.

You'll want to know: 长大

长大 — *zhǎngdà* — "to grow up".

他们长大了 *tāmen zhǎngdà le* — They've grown up.

The character you wrote for cháng, long, is read zhǎng here, to grow.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

长大 (*zhǎngdà*) is built from zhǎng 'to grow' and 大 'big', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjangX* and *dajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as 'big' and 'elder'; growing is not given there, so how it got that sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎngdà*
- *Say it: zhǎngdà*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen zhǎngdà le* — They've grown up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for really, then the Mandarin for how old, then say *zhǎngdà* again

Before you move on

What does 长大 mean? ("To grow up".) Say it once more.

78.3 前 (qián) — before; ago; front

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how old, then the Mandarin for to grow up.

You'll want to know: 前

前 — *qián* — "before; ago; front".

三年前我八岁 *sān nián qián wǒ bā suì* — Three years ago I was eight.

The new character, in pieces: 前 — two horns over a bar, the moon piece read yuè on the left, and a blade of two verticals on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

前 (*qián*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'before, first'.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: qián*
- *Say it: qián*, once more
- *Say it: sān nián qián wǒ bā suì* — Three years ago I was eight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how old, then the Mandarin for to grow up, then say *qián* again

Before you move on

What does 前 mean? ("Before; ago; front".) Say it once more.

78.4 前 — horns, a bar, the moon and a blade

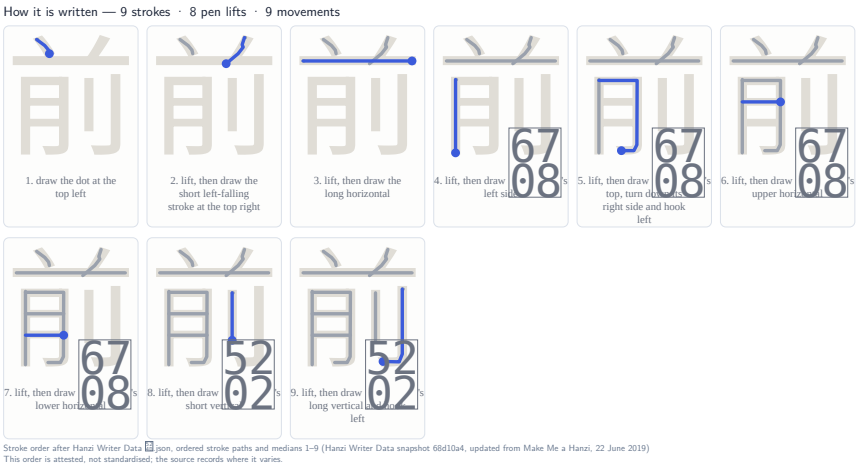
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qián* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  三 年

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *sān*, *nián*

Script — horns, a bar, the moon and a blade



How 前 *is written, stroke by stroke*

前

Two horns, two strokes: a dot on the left, a short left-falling stroke on the right.

A long horizontal under them.

The moon piece, four strokes, read yuè as in the word for month: a left side that falls down, a top that turns down the right side and hooks, and two short bars inside.

The blade, two strokes: a short vertical, then a long vertical that hooks to the left.

2 + 1 + 4 + 2 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 前, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 前? (**Nine.**) What comes after the horns? (**The long bar.**) Which stroke hooks last? (**The long vertical on the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 前, pinned stroke paths and medians.

78.5 niánjì — age (of a person)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to grow up, then the Mandarin for ago.

You'll want to know: niánjì

niánjì — "age (of a person)".

nǐ bàba duō dà niánjì — How old is your father?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niánjì is built from 年 'year' and jì, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nen* and *kiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as a span of twelve years.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: niánjì*
- *Say it: niánjì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bàba duō dà niánjì* — How old is your father?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to grow up, then the Mandarin for ago, then say *niánjì* again

Before you move on

What does niánjì mean? ("Age (of a person)".) Say it once more.

78.6 xiǎoshíhou — in childhood; when one was little

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ago, then the Mandarin for age.

You'll want to know: xiǎoshíhou

xiǎoshíhou — "in childhood; when one was little".

wǒ xiǎoshíhou hěn xǐhuan xiào — As a child I laughed a lot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiǎoshíhou is built from 小 'small' and shíhou 'time', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX*, *dzyi* and *huwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the time when you were small.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou*
- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎoshíhou hěn xǐhuan xiào* — As a child I laughed a lot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ago, then the Mandarin for age, then say *xiǎoshíhou* again

Before you move on

What does xiǎoshíhou mean? (“In childhood; when one was little”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 79

At School

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about classes, the classroom, homework and exams.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 79: I can talk about classes, the classroom, homework and exams.*

79.1 上课 (shàngkè) — to have class; to start class

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for age, then the Mandarin for in childhood.

You'll want to know: 上课

上课 — *shàngkè* — "to have class; to start class".

> 今天有汉语课我们一会儿上课 *jīntiān yǒu hànyǔ kè wǒmen yíhuìr shàngkè* — There's a Chinese class today; it starts in a moment.

The new character, in pieces: 课 — 讠 on the left, and on the right guǒ, the fruit of shuǐguǒ: a box over the tree piece. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上课 (*shàngkè*) is built from 上 'to go up to' and 课 'lesson', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *khwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second as 'a tax' and 'a test'; the sense lesson is not given there.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngkè*
- *Say it: shàngkè*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān yǒu hànyǔ kè wǒmen yíhuìr shàngkè* — There's a Chinese class today; it starts in a moment.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for age, then the Mandarin for in childhood, then say *shàngkè* again

Before you move on

What does 上课 mean? ("To have class; to start class".) Say it once more.

79.2 课 — the speech piece, then guǒ

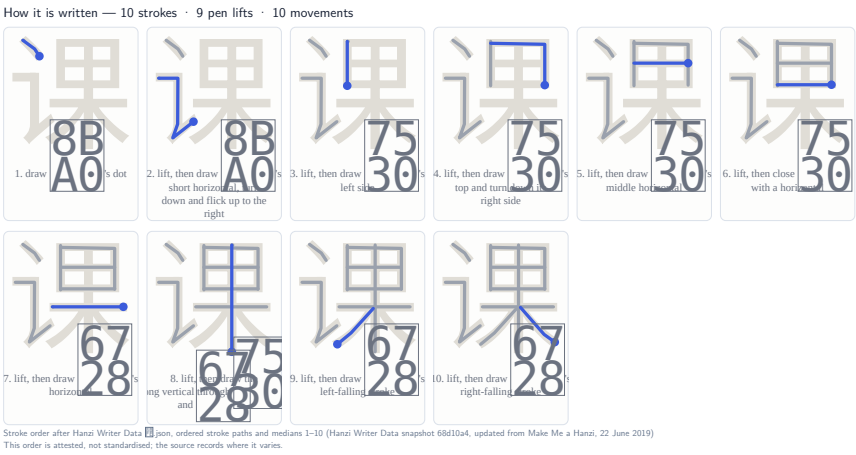
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shàngkè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  讠 说

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — the speech piece, *shuō*

Script — the speech piece, then guǒ



How 课 *is written, stroke by stroke*

课

Two pieces, left before right.
讠 **, two strokes**, as in 说 and 话.
Guǒ, eight strokes: a box like 日, its left side, the top that turns down, the middle bar and the bar that closes it; then a long horizontal, a vertical down through the box and the bar, a left-falling stroke and a stroke falling to the right.
2 + 8 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 课, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 课? (**Two.**) Which characters you know start the same way? (**说 and 话.**) What runs down through the box? (**The vertical, the eighth stroke.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 课, pinned stroke paths and medians.

79.3 下课 (xiàkè) — to finish class

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in childhood, then the Mandarin for to start class.

You'll want to know: 下课

下课 — *xiàkè* — "to finish class".

十二点前我们下课 *shí'èr diǎn qián wǒmen xiàkè* — We finish class before twelve.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

下课 (*xiàkè*) is built from 下 'to go down from' and 课 'lesson', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *khwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); lesson is not among the senses the dictionary gives the second.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàkè*
- *Say it: xiàkè*, once more
- *Say it: shí'èr diǎn qián wǒmen xiàkè* — We finish class before twelve.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in childhood, then the Mandarin for to start class, then say *xiàkè* again

Before you move on

What does 下课 mean? ("To finish class".) Say it once more.

79.4 jiàoshì — classroom

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to start class, then the Mandarin for to finish class.

You'll want to know: jiàoshì

jiàoshì — "classroom".

> *wǒmen de jiàoshì hěn dà* — Our classroom is big.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàoshì is built from jiào 'to teach' and shì 'room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewH* and *syit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàoshì*
- *Say it: jiàoshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de jiàoshì hěn dà* — Our classroom is big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to start class, then the Mandarin for to finish class, then say *jiàoshì* again

Before you move on

What does jiàoshì mean? ("Classroom".) Say it once more.

79.5 zuòyè — homework

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to finish class, then the Mandarin for classroom.

You'll want to know: zuòyè

zuòyè — "homework".

> *jīntiān de zuòyè shì dú hànzì* — Today's homework is reading characters aloud.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuòyè is built from zuò 'to do' and yè 'task', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsak* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòyè*
- *Say it: zuòyè*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de zuòyè shì dú hànzì* — Today's homework is reading characters aloud.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to finish class, then the Mandarin for classroom, then say *zuòyè* again

Before you move on

What does zuòyè mean? ("Homework".) Say it once more.

79.6 kǎoshì — to take an exam

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for classroom, then the Mandarin for homework.

You'll want to know: kǎoshì

kǎoshì — "to take an exam".

míngtiān kǎoshì jīntiān wǒ xuéxí — The exam is tomorrow, so today I'm studying.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kǎoshì is built from kǎo and shì, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khawX* and *syiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as 'to check' and the second as 'to use'; the sense 'exam' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǎoshì*
- *Say it: kǎoshì*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān kǎoshì jīntiān wǒ xuéxí* — The exam is tomorrow, so today I'm studying.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for classroom, then the Mandarin for homework, then say *kǎoshì* again

Before you move on

What does kǎoshì mean? ("To take an exam".) Say it once more.

79.7 Looking back: from Celebrating to At School

Say the Mandarin for joyful and birthday.

Your turn

- *Say it:* joyful, birthday, cake, present, to give as a present
- *Say it:* a little while, see you tomorrow, to leave it till later, good night, bye-bye
- *Say it:* don't mention it, to trouble somebody, to thank, extremely, really

- *Say it:* how old, to grow up, ago, age, in childhood
- *Say it:* to start class, to finish class, classroom, homework, to take an exam
- *Read it:* 乐 会 前 课 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Joyful? (快乐, *kuàilè.*) Birthday? (生日, *shēngrì.*) Cake? (*dàngāo.*) Present? (*lǐwù.*) To give as a present? (*sòng.*) A little while? (一会儿, *yíhuìr.*) See you tomorrow? (明天见, *míngtiān jiàn.*) To leave it till later? (再说, *zàishuō.*) Good night? (*wǎn'ān.*) Bye-bye? (*bàibai.*) Don't mention it? (不客气, *bú kèqi.*) To trouble somebody? (*máfan.*) To thank? (*gǎnxiè.*) Extremely? (*fēicháng.*) Really? (*zhēn.*) How old? (多大, *duō dà.*) To grow up? (长大, *zhǎngdà.*) Ago? (前, *qián.*) Age? (*niánjì.*) In childhood? (*xiǎoshíhou.*) To start class? (上课, *shàngkè.*) To finish class? (下课, *xiàkè.*) Classroom? (*jiàoshì.*) Homework? (*zuòyè.*) To take an exam? (*kǎoshì.*)

Chapter 80

Jobs

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who goes to work where: workers, drivers, doctors and companies.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 80: I can say who goes to work where: workers, drivers, doctors and companies.*

80.1 shàngbān — to go to work

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for homework, then the Mandarin for to take an exam.

You'll want to know: shàngbān

shàngbān — "to go to work".

> *wǒ jiǔ diǎn shàngbān* — I start work at nine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shàngbān is built from 上 'to go up to' and bān, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *paen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the second, through an older book, as dividing up jade tallies; a shift of work is a likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngbān*
- *Say it: shàngbān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiǔ diǎn shàngbān* — I start work at nine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for homework, then the Mandarin for to take an exam, then say *shàngbān* again

Before you move on

What does shàngbān mean? ("To go to work".) Say it once more.

80.2 gōngrén — worker

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take an exam, then the Mandarin for to go to work.

You'll want to know: gōngrén

gōngrén — "worker".

wǒ bàba shì gōngrén — My dad is a worker.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngrén is built from gōng 'craft, work' and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngrén*
- *Say it: gōngrén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba shì gōngrén* — My dad is a worker.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take an exam, then the Mandarin for to go to work, then say *gōngrén* again

Before you move on

What does gōngrén mean? ("Worker".) Say it once more.

80.3 sījī — driver

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go to work, then the Mandarin for worker.

You'll want to know: sījī

sījī — "driver".

tā shì chūzūchē sījī — He's a taxi driver.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sījī is built from sī 'to be in charge' and 机 'machine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *si* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the one in charge of the machine.

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: sījī*
- *Say it: sījī*, once more

- *Say it: tā shì chūzūchē sījī* — He's a taxi driver.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go to work, then the Mandarin for worker, then say *sījī* again

Before you move on

What does sījī mean? ("Driver".) Say it once more.

80.4 yīshēng — doctor

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for worker, then the Mandarin for driver.

You'll want to know: yīshēng

yīshēng — "doctor".

wǒ māma shì yīshēng — My mum is a doctor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīshēng is built from yī 'healing' and 生, as in 学生 and in xiānsheng, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'i* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīshēng*
- *Say it: yīshēng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma shì yīshēng* — My mum is a doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for worker, then the Mandarin for driver, then say *yīshēng* again

Before you move on

What does yīshēng mean? (“Doctor”.) Say it once more.

80.5 gōngsī — company; firm

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for driver, then the Mandarin for doctor.

You’ll want to know: gōngsī

gōngsī — “company; firm”.

wǒ de gōngsī hěn dà — My company is big.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngsī is built from gōng ’public, shared’ and sī ’to manage’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *si* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription).

What you’ve built

One more word about people.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngsī*
- *Say it: gōngsī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de gōngsī hěn dà* — My company is big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for driver, then the Mandarin for doctor, then say *gōngsī* again

Before you move on

What does gōngsī mean? (“Company; firm”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 81

The City

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about cities and places, say inside and beside, and talk about abroad.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 81: I can talk about cities and places, say inside and beside, and talk about abroad.*

81.1 里 (lǐ) — inside; in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for doctor, then the Mandarin for company.

You'll want to know: 里

里 — *lǐ* — "inside; in".

山里有马 *shān lǐ yǒu mǎ* — There are horses up in the hills.

The new character, in pieces: 里 — 日 with a vertical running down through it, standing on two bars. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

里 (*lǐ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'inside' and, through an older book, 'the inside of a garment'.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐ*
- *Say it: lǐ*, once more
- *Say it: shān lǐ yǒu mǎ* — There are horses up in the hills.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for doctor, then the Mandarin for company, then say *lǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 里 mean? ("Inside; in".) Say it once more.

81.2 里 — 日, a line through it, two bars

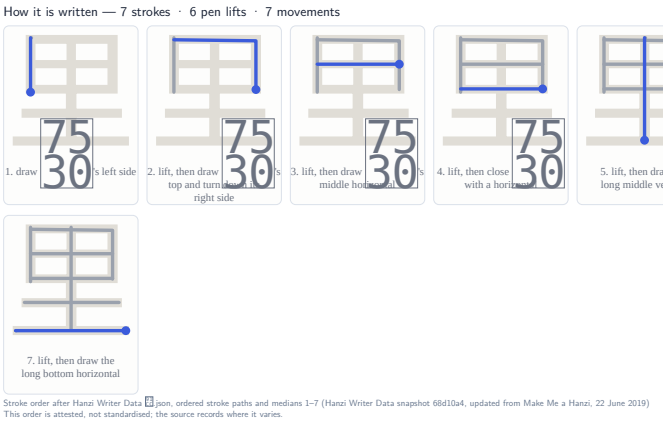
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 家

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *jiā*

Script — 日, a line through it, two bars



How 里 *is written, stroke by stroke*

里

One piece, built from the top down.

日**, four strokes**: the left side, the top that turns down, the middle bar, the bottom bar.

A vertical down the middle, through 日 and on below it.

Two horizontals, a short one across the vertical, then a long one along the bottom.

4 + 1 + 2 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 里, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 里? (**Seven.**) Which character you know is at the top? (日.) Which bar is longest? (**The last, along the bottom.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 里, pinned stroke paths and medians.

81.3 chéngshì — city

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for company, then the Mandarin for inside.

You'll want to know: chéngshì

chéngshì — "city".

Běijīng shì yí ge dà chéngshì — Beijing is a big city.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngshì is built from chéng 'city walls' and shì 'market', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *dzyiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngshì*
- *Say it: chéngshì*, once more
- *Say it: Běijīng shì yí ge dà chéngshì* — Beijing is a big city.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for company, then the Mandarin for inside, then say *chéngshì* again

Before you move on

What does chéngshì mean? ("City".) Say it once more.

81.4 dìfang — place

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for inside, then the Mandarin for city.

You'll want to know: dìfang

dìfang — "place".

zhège dìfang hěn hǎo — This is a nice place.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìfang is built from dì 'land' and fāng 'quarter, region', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *pjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìfang*
- *Say it: dìfang*, once more
- *Say it: zhège dìfang hěn hǎo* — This is a nice place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for inside, then the Mandarin for city, then say *dìfang* again

Before you move on

What does dìfang mean? ("Place".) Say it once more.

81.5 wàiguó — foreign country; abroad

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for city, then the Mandarin for place.

You'll want to know: wàiguó

wàiguó — "foreign country; abroad".

tā shì wàiguó rén — He's a foreigner.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàiguó is built from wài 'outside' and 国 'country', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàiguó*
- *Say it: wàiguó*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wàiguó rén* — He's a foreigner.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for city, then the Mandarin for place, then say *wàiguó* again

Before you move on

What does wàiguó mean? ("Foreign country; abroad".) Say it once more.

81.6 pángbiān — side; beside

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for place, then the Mandarin for abroad.

You'll want to know: pángbiān

pángbiān — "side; beside".

wǒ jiā pángbiān yǒu yí ge shāngdiàn — There's a shop next to my home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pángbiān is built from páng 'side' and biān 'edge', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bang* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: pángbiān*
- *Say it: pángbiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā pángbiān yǒu yí ge shāngdiàn* — There's a shop next to my home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for place, then the Mandarin for abroad, then say *pángbiān* again

Before you move on

What does pángbiān mean? ("Side; beside".) Say it once more.

Chapter 82

Behind, Left and Right

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say after, left, right, in the middle and opposite.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 82: I can say after, left, right, in the middle and opposite.*

82.1 hòu — after; behind; later

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for abroad, then the Mandarin for beside.

You'll want to know: hòu

hòu — "after; behind; later".

> *sān tiān hòu wǒmen qù Běijīng* — In three days we're going to Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hòu is inherited from Middle Chinese *huwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed with the pair 'before and after'; the dictionary writes it with the traditional form of the character.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòu*
- *Say it: hòu*, once more
- *Say it: sān tiān hòu wǒmen qù Běijīng* — In three days we're going to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for abroad, then the Mandarin for beside, then say *hòu* again

Before you move on

What does hòu mean? ("After; behind; later".) Say it once more.

82.2 zuǒbian — the left; on the left

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for beside, then the Mandarin for after.

You'll want to know: zuǒbian

zuǒbian — "the left; on the left".

zuǒbian shì wǒ de fángjiān — My room is on the left.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuǒbian is built from zuǒ 'left' and bian 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsaX* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuǒbian*
- *Say it: zuǒbian*, once more
- *Say it: zuǒbian shì wǒ de fángjiān* — My room is on the left.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for beside, then the Mandarin for after, then say *zuǒbian* again

Before you move on

What does zuǒbian mean? ("The left; on the left".) Say it once more.

82.3 yòubian — the right; on the right

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for after, then the Mandarin for the left side.

You'll want to know: yòubian

yòubian — "the right; on the right".

yòubian shì shāngdiàn — The shop is on the right.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yòubian is built from yòu 'right' and bian 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: yòubian*
- *Say it: yòubian*, once more

- *Say it: yòubian shì shāngdiàn* — The shop is on the right.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for after, then the Mandarin for the left side, then say *yòubian* again

Before you move on

What does yòubian mean? ("The right; on the right".) Say it once more.

82.4 zhōngjiān — the middle; between

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the left side, then the Mandarin for the right side.

You'll want to know: zhōngjiān

zhōngjiān — "the middle; between".

zhōngjiān nàge shì wǒ — The one in the middle is me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhōngjiān is built from 中 'middle' and jiān 'a gap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *kean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the second under an older form of the character.

What you've built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōngjiān*
- *Say it: zhōngjiān*, once more
- *Say it: zhōngjiān nàge shì wǒ* — The one in the middle is me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the left side, then the Mandarin for the right side, then say *zhōngjiān* again

Before you move on

What does zhōngjiān mean? (“The middle; between”.) Say it once more.

82.5 duìmiàn — opposite; across from

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the right side, then the Mandarin for the middle.

You’ll want to know: duìmiàn

duìmiàn — “opposite; across from”.

wǒ jiā duìmiàn yǒu yí ge fàndiàn — There’s a restaurant across from my home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duìmiàn is built from 对 ’to face’ and miàn ’face’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *twojH* and *mjienH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription): face to face.

What you’ve built

One more word for meeting people.

Your turn

- *Say it: duìmiàn*
- *Say it: duìmiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā duìmiàn yǒu yí ge fàndiàn* — There’s a restaurant across from my home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the right side, then the Mandarin for the middle, then say *duìmiàn* again

Before you move on

What does duìmiàn mean? (“Opposite; across from”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 83

Running Late

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask if somebody is free, and say early, right away, too late and late.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 83: I can ask if somebody is free, and say early, right away, too late and late.*

83.1 shíjiān — time; free time

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the middle, then the Mandarin for opposite.

You'll want to know: shíjiān

shíjiān — "time; free time".

> *nǐ míngtiān yǒu shíjiān ma* — Are you free tomorrow?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shíjiān is built from shí 'time' and jiān 'a gap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyi* and *kean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first with another word for a time, and lists the second under an older form of the character.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: shíjiān*
- *Say it: shíjiān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ míngtiān yǒu shíjiān ma* — Are you free tomorrow?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the middle, then the Mandarin for opposite, then say *shíjiān* again

Before you move on

What does shíjiān mean? ("Time; free time".) Say it once more.

83.2 早 (zǎo) — early

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for opposite, then the Mandarin for time to spare.

You'll want to know: 早

早 — *zǎo* — "early".

明天的火车很早 *míngtiān de huǒchē hěn zǎo* — Tomorrow's train leaves early.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

早 (*zǎo*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'morning'. Early is not given there; from morning to early is the likely step, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǎo*
- *Say it: zǎo*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān de huǒchē hěn zǎo* — Tomorrow's train leaves early.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for opposite, then the Mandarin for time to spare, then say *zǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 早 mean? ("Early".) Say it once more.

83.3 马上 (mǎshàng) — at once; right away

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for time to spare, then the Mandarin for early.

You'll want to know: 马上

马上 — *mǎshàng* — "at once; right away".

家里人马上来 *jiā lǐ rén mǎshàng lái* — The family will be here any minute.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

马上 (*mǎshàng*) is built from 马 'horse' and 上 'on', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maeX* and *dzyangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'On horseback', so already on the way, is the usual explanation, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎshàng*
- *Say it: mǎshàng*, once more

- *Say it: jiā lǐ rén mǎshàng lái* — The family will be here any minute.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for time to spare, then the Mandarin for early, then say *mǎshàng* again

Before you move on

What does 马上 mean? ("At once; right away".) Say it once more.

83.4 láibují — to run out of time

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for early, then the Mandarin for right away.

You'll want to know: láibují

láibují — "to run out of time".

xiànzài qù láibují le — It's too late to go now.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Its middle syllable loses its tone: láibují, with bu light between two full syllables.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

láibují is built from 来 'to come', 不 'not' and jí 'to reach', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *loj*, *pjut* and *gip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): coming, but not reaching in time.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: láibují*
- *Say it: láibují*, once more
- *Say it: xiànzài qù láibují le* — It's too late to go now.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for early, then the Mandarin for right away, then say *láibují* again

Before you move on

What does láibují mean? ("To run out of time".) Say it once more.

83.5 chídào — to be late; to arrive late

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for right away, then the Mandarin for to run out of time.

You'll want to know: chídào

chídào — "to be late; to arrive late".

duìbuqǐ wǒ chídào le — Sorry I'm late.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chídào is built from chí 'slow' and dào 'to arrive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drij* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: chídào*
- *Say it: chídào*, once more
- *Say it: duìbuqǐ wǒ chídào le* — Sorry I'm late.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for right away, then the Mandarin for to run out of time, then say *chídào* again

Before you move on

What does chídào mean? (“To be late; to arrive late”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 84

Doing Things Together

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can arrange to meet, chat, take part and get ready together.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 84: I can arrange to meet, chat, take part and get ready together.*

84.1 一起 (yìqǐ) — together

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to run out of time, then the Mandarin for to be late.

You'll want to know: 一起

一起 — *yìqǐ* — "together".

> 三年前我们一起上学 *sān nián qián wǒmen yìqǐ shàngxué* — Three years ago we were at school together.

yī changes its tone here, falling to yì before the dipping qǐ: yìqǐ.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一起 (*yìqǐ*) is built from 一 'one' and 起 'to rise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *khiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Rising as one is a likely picture, but how the pair came to mean together is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìqǐ*
- *Say it: yìqǐ*, once more
- *Say it: sān nián qián wǒmen yìqǐ shàngxué* — Three years ago we were at school together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to run out of time, then the Mandarin for to be late, then say *yìqǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 一起 mean? ("Together".) Say it once more.

84.2 jiànmiàn — to meet up; to see each other

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be late, then the Mandarin for together.

You'll want to know: jiànmiàn

jiànmiàn — "to meet up; to see each other".

wǒmen xīngqītiān jiànmiàn — We're meeting on Sunday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiànmiàn is built from 见 'to see' and miàn 'face', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kenH* and *mjienH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to see each other's face.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànmiàn*
- *Say it: jiànmiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xīngqītiān jiànmiàn* — We're meeting on Sunday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be late, then the Mandarin for together, then say *jiànmiàn* again

Before you move on

What does jiànmiàn mean? ("To meet up; to see each other".) Say it once more.

84.3 liáotiān — to chat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for together, then the Mandarin for to meet up.

You'll want to know: liáotiān

liáotiān — "to chat".

wǒmen hē chá liáotiān — We drink tea and chat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liáotiān is built from liáo and 天 'sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lew* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as a helping word; how the pair came to mean chatting is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: liáotiān*
- *Say it: liáotiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen hē chá liáotiān* — We drink tea and chat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for together, then the Mandarin for to meet up, then say *liáotiān* again

Before you move on

What does liáotiān mean? ("To chat".) Say it once more.

84.4 cānjiā — to take part in; to join

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to meet up, then the Mandarin for to chat.

You'll want to know: cānjiā

cānjiā — "to take part in; to join".

nǐ xiǎng cānjiā ma — Would you like to join in?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cānjiā is built from cān 'to attend' and jiā 'to add', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshom* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: cānjiā*
- *Say it: cānjiā*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ xiǎng cānjiā ma* — Would you like to join in?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to meet up, then the Mandarin for to chat, then say *cānjiā* again

Before you move on

What does cānjiā mean? ("To take part in; to join".) Say it once more.

84.5 zhǔnbèi — to get ready; to prepare

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to chat, then the Mandarin for to take part.

You'll want to know: zhǔnbèi

zhǔnbèi — "to get ready; to prepare".

wǒ zhǔnbèi chànggē — I'm getting ready to sing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔnbèi is built from zhǔn 'level, a standard' and bèi 'to have ready', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsywinX* and *bijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔnbèi*
- *Say it: zhǔnbèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhǔnbèi chànggē* — I'm getting ready to sing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to chat, then the Mandarin for to take part, then say *zhǔnbèi* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔnbèi mean? ("To get ready; to prepare".) Say it once more.

84.6 Looking back: from Jobs to Doing Things Together

Say the Mandarin for to go to work and worker.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to go to work, worker, driver, doctor, company
- *Say it:* inside, city, place, abroad, beside
- *Say it:* after, the left side, the right side, the middle, opposite
- *Say it:* time to spare, early, right away, to run out of time, to be late
- *Say it:* together, to meet up, to chat, to take part, to get ready
- *Read it:* 里 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To go to work? (*shàngbān.*) Worker? (*gōngrén.*) Driver? (*sījī.*) Doctor? (*yīshēng.*) Company? (*gōngsī.*) Inside? (里, *lǐ.*) City? (*chéngshì.*) Place? (*dìfang.*) Abroad? (*wàiguó.*) Beside? (*pángbiān.*) After? (*hòu.*) The left side? (*zuǒbian.*) The right side? (*yòubian.*) The middle? (*zhōngjiān.*) Opposite? (*duìmiàn.*) Time to spare? (*shíjiān.*) Early? (早, *zǎo.*) Right away? (马上, *mǎshàng.*) To run out of time? (*láibují.*) To be late? (*chídào.*) Together? (一起, *yìqǐ.*) To meet up? (*jiànmiàn.*) To chat? (*liáotiān.*) To take part? (*cānjiā.*) To get ready? (*zhǔnbèi.*)

84.7 Doing Things Together — once more

Say the Mandarin for together and to meet up.

Your turn

- *Say it:* together, to meet up, to chat, to take part, to get ready

Before you move on

Together? (一起, *yìqǐ.*) To meet up? (*jiànmiàn.*) To chat? (*liáotiān.*) To take part? (*cānjiā.*) To get ready? (*zhǔnbèi.*)

Chapter 85

Where Things Are

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where people and things are, and write 在.
>
> *Saying where people and things are with* 在*, here and there, inside and outside, built on one new written character:* 在*.*

85.1 在 (zài) — at, in; to be somewhere

A new chapter, and it opens with the word that puts people and things in places.

- *Recall:* say *zhǔnbèi*, to get ready — **R1**, the last word you met
- *Recall:* say 这儿 — *zhèr*, here — **R3**, durable, from the chapter on home
- *Recall:* say *pángbiān*, beside — **R2**, a few chapters back

You'll want to know: 在

在 — *zài* — "to be at; in, at".

妈妈在家吗 *māma zài jiā ma* — Is Mum at home?

我在这儿 *wǒ zài zhèr* — I'm here.

The next lesson puts the character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

在 (*zài*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to dwell' and 'to exist'.

What you've built

The place comes straight after 在: 妈妈, 在, 家. English needs *is* and *at*; Mandarin needs 在 alone.
That is the whole sentence pattern of the chapter: a person or a thing, then 在, then the place.

Your turn

- *Say it: zài*
- *Say it:* 妈妈在家吗 — *māma zài jiā ma* — Is Mum at home?
- *Say it:* 我在这儿 — *wǒ zài zhèr* — I'm here.
- *Recall:* say *zhǔnbèi* and *pángbiān*, then *zài* again

Before you move on

What does 在 mean? ("To be at; in, at".) Where does the place go? (**Straight after** 在.)

85.2 在 — the top of 有, a vertical, then 土

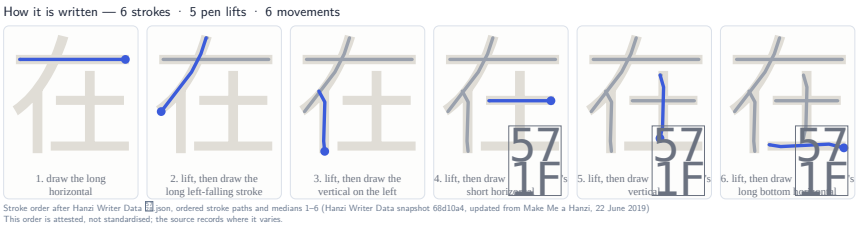
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  有 里 十

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yǒu*, *lǐ*, *shí*

Script — the top of 有, a vertical, then 土



How 在 is written, stroke by stroke

在

Three pieces, and two of them you already write.

The top of 有, two strokes: a long horizontal, then a long left-falling stroke from above it, down to the lower left.

A short vertical under them, on the left, down from the falling stroke.

土, three strokes: a short horizontal, a vertical down through it, and a long bar along the foot. It is 十 standing on a bar.

2 + 1 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 在, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 在? (**Six.**) Which character you know opens the same way? (有.) Which bar is longest? (**The last, along the foot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 在, pinned stroke paths and medians.

85.3 那儿 (nàr) — there

Before the new one: the character from the last lesson, then a word it pairs with.

- *Read it:* 在家, aloud — *zài jiā*, at home
- *Recall:* say 这儿 — *zhèr*, here

You'll want to know: 那儿

那儿 — *nàr* — "there".

他在那儿 *tā zài nàr* — He's over there.

我在这儿 *wǒ zài zhèr* — I'm here.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

那儿 (*nàr*) is built from 那 'that' and 儿, the ending that runs into the syllable before it as an r: the same two pieces as 这儿. The Guangyun records 那 as *na* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'how, what'; how it came to mean 'that' is not settled.

What you've built

这儿 and 那儿, here and there, answer most of the place questions this chapter asks. Both take the r ending, and both follow 在.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nàr*
- *nàr*, once more
- 他在那儿 — *tā zài nàr* — He's over there.
- 我在这儿 你在那儿 — *wǒ zài zhèr, nǐ zài nàr* — I'm here, you're there.

Before you move on

What does 那儿 mean? ("There".) And here? (这儿.) Say both once more.

85.4 lǐbian — inside

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and a character you write.

- *Recall:* say 那儿 — *nàr*, there
- *Read it:* 里, aloud — *lǐ*, inside
- *Recall:* say *chéngshì*, a city

You'll want to know: lǐbian

lǐbian — "inside; in".

shū zài bāo lǐbian — The book is in the bag.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǐbian is built from lǐ 'inside', the 里 you write, and bian 'side', the syllable that ends *zuǒbian* and *pángbiān*. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *liX* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the inside of a garment' and 'an edge; a side'.

What you've built

lǐbian comes after the thing whose inside it names: *bāo lǐbian*, inside the bag. Put 在 in front and it is a place: *zài bāo lǐbian*.
里 on its own does the same job in a quicker sentence, as in *shān lǐ*.
lǐbian can also stand alone: *zài lǐbian*, inside.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐbian*
- *Say it: lǐbian*, once more
- *Say it: shū zài bāo lǐbian* — The book is in the bag.
- *Say it: tā zài lǐbian* — He's inside.
- *Recall:* say *nàr* and *chéngshì*, then *lǐbian* again

Before you move on

What does *lǐbian* mean? (“Inside; in”.) Which written character does it open with? (里.)

85.5 wàibian — outside

Before the new one: say the word for inside, then two words you have had for a while.

- *Recall:* say *lǐbian*, inside — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *wàiguó*, abroad — **R2**, a few chapters back
- *Recall:* say *zuǒbian* and *yòubian*, left and right — **R2**

You’ll want to know: wàibian

wàibian — “outside”.

tā zài wàibian — She’s outside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàibian is built from wài ’outside’, the wài of *wàiguó*, and bian ’side’. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), *ngwajH* glossed ’the outside’ and ’far’.

What you’ve built

lǐbian and *wàibian*, inside and outside, beside the pair you already own, *zuǒbian* and *yòubian*: one ending, bian, makes all four, and all four follow 在.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàibian*
- *Say it: wàibian*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài wàibian* — She’s outside.

- *Say it: māo zài wàibian* — The cat's outside.
- *Recall:* say *lǐbian* and *wàiguó*, then *wàibian* again

Before you move on

What does *wàibian* mean? ("Outside".) And inside? (***lǐbian***.)

85.6 我在这儿 — 你在那儿

The chapter closes here, with two people placing themselves and their things.

- *Recall:* say *wàibian*, outside — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *yìqǐ*, together — **R2**, the first real retrieval
- *Recall:* say *jiànmiàn*, to meet up — **R2**

The exchange

A: 我在家 你呢

wǒ zài jiā, nǐ ne — I'm at home. And you?

B: *wǒ zài xuéxiào* — I'm at school.

A: 你的书呢

nǐ de shū ne — Where's your book?

B: *zài bāo lǐbian* — In my bag.

A: *māo ne* — And the cat?

B: *māo zài wàibian* — The cat's outside.

A: 他呢

tā ne — And him?

B: 他在那儿

tā zài nàr — He's over there.

nǐ de shū ne asks where the book is: 呢 after a thing, with nothing else, means *and where is it?* The answer drops the book and starts at 在.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — one pattern, four places

One pattern, a person or a thing, then 在, then the place:

- 我在这儿 *wǒ zài zhèr* — I'm here.
- 他在那儿 *tā zài nàr* — he's there.
- *shū zài bāo lǐbian* — the book is in the bag.
- *māo zài wàibian* — the cat is outside.

Listen. *Nǐ de shǒujī ne?*
Speak. Place yourself, then somebody you know, then your phone.
Write it: 在 — the top of 有, a short vertical, then 十 on a long bar

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我在家 你呢 — *wǒ zài jiā, nǐ ne* — I'm at home. And you?
- *Say it:* 你的书呢 — *nǐ de shū ne* — Where's your book?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我在这儿

Before you move on

Say you are at home. (我在家.) Say the book is in the bag. (*shū zài bāo lǐbian.*) Ask where somebody's book is, with three characters. (你的书呢.)

Chapter 86

Where Is It?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask where something is and understand the answer.
>
> *Asking where with* 哪儿 *and placing the answer in the same slot, on top of, under, and the question every traveller needs, built on one new written character:* 哪*.*

86.1 哪儿 (nǎr) — where?

A new chapter, and it opens with the question the last one kept answering.

- *Recall:* say 我在这儿 — *wǒ zài zhèr*, then 他在那儿 — *tā zài nàr* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *wàibian*, outside — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *nǐ shì nǎ guó rén*, which country are you from — **R4**, from the chapter on where people come from
- *Recall:* say *liáotiān*, to chat — **R2**

You'll want to know: 哪儿

哪儿 — *nǎr* — "where?".

> 你在哪儿 *nǐ zài nǎr* — Where are you?
>
> 我在那儿 *wǒ zài nàr* — I'm over there.

The next lesson puts the new character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

哪儿 (*nǎr*) is built from 哪 'which', the *nǎ* of *nǐ shì nǎ guó rén*, and the r ending 儿. 哪 has no reading in the Guangyun: no dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

The answer goes where the question word was, and nothing else moves: 你在哪儿 — 我在那儿. Only the tone tells the two words apart: *nǎr*, with the dip, asks; *nàr*, with the fall, answers.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǎr* — the dip
- *Say it: nàr* — the fall
- *Say it:* 你在哪儿 — *nǐ zài nǎr* — Where are you?
- *Say it:* 我在那儿 — *wǒ zài nàr* — I'm over there.
- *Recall:* say *liáotiān*, then ask where somebody is

Before you move on

What does 哪儿 ask? ("Where?".) What tells *nǎr* from *nàr*? (**The tone: the dip asks, the fall answers**.)

86.2 哪 — 口 beside the whole of 那

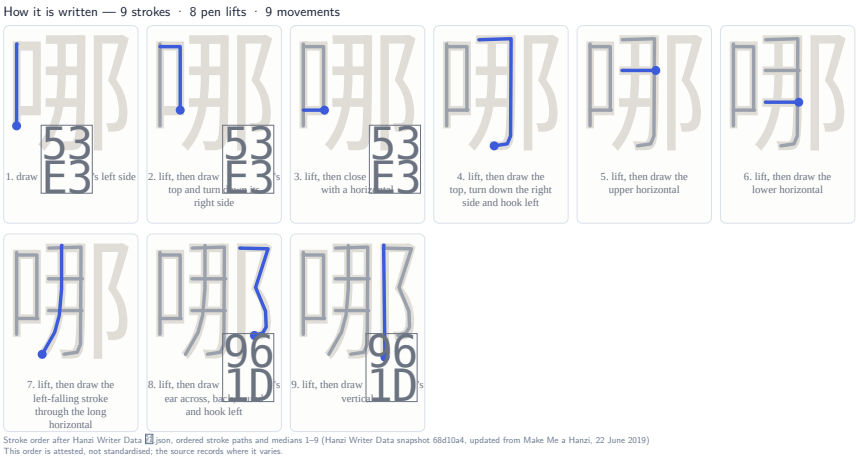
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *nǎr* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 那

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *nà*

Script — 口 beside the whole of 那



How 哪 *is written, stroke by stroke*

哪

Two characters you own, side by side. Nothing in it is new.

口**, three strokes**, small, on the left: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the bottom bar.

那**, six strokes**, whole, as you write it alone: the hooked turn across the top and down the right, the upper bar, the lower bar, the left-falling stroke through them, then the ear on the right, across, back, round and hooking, and its long vertical.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 哪, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 哪? (**Nine**.) Which two characters sit side by side? (口 **and** 那.) What tells 哪 from 那 when you say them? (**The tone:** ***nǎ*** **dips,** ***nà*** **falls**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 哪, pinned stroke paths and medians.

86.3 shàngbian — on top; above

Before the new one: read the question from the last lesson, then two words for things at home.

- *Read it:* 你在哪儿, aloud — *nǐ zài nǎr*
- *Recall:* say *zhuōzi*, a table
- *Recall:* say *zhōngjiān*, the middle

You'll want to know: shàngbian

shàngbian — "on top; above".

shū zài zhuōzi shàngbian — The book is on the table.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shàngbian is built from shàng 'above', the 上 you write, and bian 'side'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangH* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun glosses *dzyangH* as 'ruler', not 'above', so the plain sense 'on top' is assumed here rather than quoted.

What you've built

A thing, then the place word after it: *zhuōzi shàngbian*, on top of the table. With 在 in front it answers 哪儿.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngbian*
- *Say it: shàngbian*, once more
- *Say it: shū zài zhuōzi shàngbian* — The book is on the table.

- *Say it:* 我的手机在哪儿 — *wǒ de shǒujī zài nǎr* — Where's my phone?
- *Recall:* say *zhōngjiān*, then *shàngbian* again

Before you move on

What does *shàngbian* mean? ("On top; above".) Which written character does it open with? (上.)

86.4 xiàbian — under; below

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words you have had for a while.

- *Recall:* say *shàngbian*, on top — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *yǐzi*, a chair — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *duìmiàn*, opposite — **R2**

You'll want to know: xiàbian

xiàbian — "under; below".

māo zài yǐzi xiàbian — The cat is under the chair.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàbian is built from xià 'below', the 下 you write, and bian 'side'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *haeX* glossed 'to go down' and 'the bottom'.

What you've built

shàngbian and *xiàbian*, on top and under: the pair you write as 上 and 下, with the same ending as *lǐbian* and *wàibian*.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàbian*
- *Say it: xiàbian*, once more
- *Say it: māo zài yǐzi xiàbian* — The cat is under the chair.
- *Say it: shū zài zhuōzi shàngbian* — The book is on the table.
- *Recall:* say *duìmiàn*, then *xiàbian* again

Before you move on

What does *xiàbian* mean? ("Under; below".) And on top? (***shàngbian***.)

86.5 xǐshǒujiān — toilet; washroom

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the polite opener you will need with it.

- *Recall:* say *xiàbian*, under — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 请问 — *qǐngwèn*, excuse me, may I ask
- *Recall:* say *fángjiān*, a room

You'll want to know: xǐshǒujiān

xǐshǒujiān — "toilet; washroom".

qǐngwèn, xǐshǒujiān zài nǎr — Excuse me, where is the toilet?

Its first and last characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐshǒujiān is built from xǐ 'to wash', shǒu 'hand', the 手 you write, and jiān 'room', the jiān of *fángjiān*. All three are inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejX*, *syuwX* and *kean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun glosses *sejX* 'to wash' and *kean* 'a gap; between'; 'a room' is a later sense of jiān.

What you've built

qǐngwèn, xǐshǒujiān zài nǎr may be the most useful sentence in the chapter: a polite opener, the thing, 在, and the question word in the place slot.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐshǒujiān*
- *Say it: xǐshǒujiān*, once more
- *Say it: qǐngwèn, xǐshǒujiān zài nǎr* — Excuse me, where is the toilet?
- *Recall:* say *xiàbian* and *fángjiān*, then *xǐshǒujiān* again

Before you move on

What does *xǐshǒujiān* mean? ("Toilet; washroom".) Ask where it is, politely. (*qǐngwèn, xǐshǒujiān zài nǎr.*)

86.6 你在哪儿 — 我在那儿

The chapter closes here, with a phone that is not where it should be.

- *Recall:* say *xǐshǒujiān*, the toilet — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *cānjiā*, to take part — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *lǐbian*, inside — **R2**, from the chapter before

The exchange

A: 我的手机呢

wǒ de shǒujī ne — Where's my phone?

B: *zài zhuōzi shàngbian* — On the table.

A: *bú zài zhuōzi shàngbian* — It isn't on the table.

B: *zài yǐzi xiàbian* — Under the chair, then.

A: 对 谢谢

duì, xièxie — Yes. Thanks.

A: *qǐngwèn, xǐshǒujiān zài nǎr* — Excuse me, where's the toilet?

B: 在那儿

zài nàr — Over there.

A: 你在哪儿

nǐ zài nǎr — And where will you be?

B: *wǒ zài wàibian* — Outside.

Every answer starts at 在, or drops even that. The thing being looked for was named once, and the rest of the exchange leaves it out.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — one question, any answer

One question, 你在哪儿 *nǐ zài nǎr*, and the answer slots into the same place:

- 我在那儿 *wǒ zài nàr* — over there.
- *zài zhuōzi shàngbian* — on the table.
- *zài yǐzi xiàbian* — under the chair.

Listen. *Nǐ de shǒujī zài nǎr?*
Speak. Answer it three ways, then ask it back.
Write it: 哪 — 口 first, then 那

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐngwèn, xǐshǒujiān zài nǎr* — Excuse me, where's the toilet?
- *Say it:* 我的手机呢 — *wǒ de shǒujī ne* — Where's my phone?

- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 你在哪儿

Before you move on

Ask somebody where they are. (你在哪儿.) Ask politely where the toilet is. (*qǐngwèn, xǐshǒujiān zài nǎr.*) Which tone asks, *nǎr* or *nàr*? (**The dip, *nǎr***.)

Chapter 87

Is There Any?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what there is and is not, and that something did not happen.
>
> *Saying what there is and is not with* 没有*, telling* 不 *from* 没*, and naming a bed, a light, a key and a fridge, built on one new written character:* 没.

87.1 没有 (méiyǒu) — not have; there is no

A new chapter, and it opens with the other half of a word you have used since the first chapters.

- *Recall:* say 你在哪儿 — *nǐ zài nǎr*, and answer it — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *xǐshǒujiān*, the toilet — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *wǒ yǒu shíjiān*, I have time

You'll want to know: 没有

没有 — *méiyǒu* — "not have; there is no".

我没有手机 *wǒ méiyǒu shǒujī* — I don't have a phone.

这儿没有人 *zhèr méiyǒu rén* — There's nobody here.

The next lesson puts the new character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

没有 (*méiyǒu*) is built from 没 'not' and 有 'to have'. 有 is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 没 is there as *mwot*, glossed 'to sink'; the Guangyun does not give 'not', and the regular sound change from *mwot* gives mò, not méi, so how 没 came to mean 'not' and to be said méi is not settled.

What you've built

有 has its own negative, and it is 没, not 不: 没有. Both jobs of 有 go with it, 'to have' and 'there is': 我没有手机, 这儿没有人.

Your turn

- *Say it: méiyǒu*
- *Say it: méiyǒu*, once more
- *Say it:* 我没有手机 — *wǒ méiyǒu shǒujī* — I don't have a phone.
- *Say it:* 这儿没有人 — *zhèr méiyǒu rén* — There's nobody here.
- *Recall:* say *wǒ yǒu shíjiān*, then turn it round: *wǒ méiyǒu shíjiān*

Before you move on

What does 没有 mean? ("Not have; there is no".) Which negative goes with 有? (没.)

87.2 没 — water, a small roof, and 又

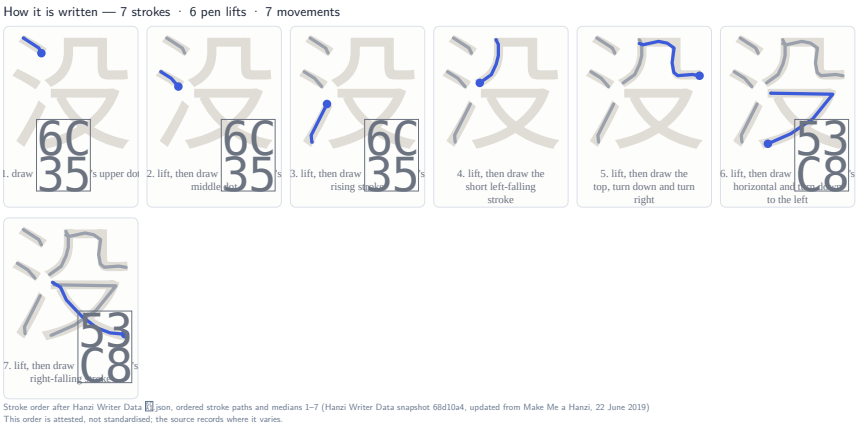
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *méiyǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  汉 对

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hàn*, *duì*

Script — water, a small roof, and 又



How 没 is written, stroke by stroke

没

Three pieces, left before right, top before bottom.

The water piece 氵, three strokes, as 汉 opens: two dots, then a stroke rising to the right.

A small roof, two strokes: a short left-falling stroke, then a horizontal that turns down and runs out to the right.

又, two strokes, under the roof, as 对 opens: across and falling to the left, then the long stroke falling to the right.

3 + 2 + 2 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 没, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 没? (**Seven.**) Which character opens with the same water piece? (汉.) Which shape sits under the roof? (**又, as in 对.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 没, pinned stroke paths and medians.

87.3 不 — 没: two words for not

Two words for 'not', and this lesson sorts them.

- *Read it:* 没有, aloud — *méiyǒu*
- *Recall:* say 不 — *bù*, not
- *Recall:* say 好不好 — *hǎo bu hǎo*, is that all right?

Grammar Lens: 不 for now and for habit, 没 for what did not happen

不 says no about now, about habit, and about what you will or won't do. 没 says something did not happen.

我不去 *wǒ bú qù* — I'm not going; I don't go. 我没去 *wǒ méi qù* — I didn't go.

Same verb, same person; the negative alone moves the sentence from a decision to a report. 不 before the fall of 去 is *bú*, as in *bú shì*. And 有 takes 没 every time, which is how the question works:

你有没有手机 *nǐ yǒu méiyǒu shǒujī* — Do you have a phone?

It is the same yes-or-no shape as 好不好: the verb, its negative, the verb again. The answer is 有 or 没有.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我不去 — *wǒ bú qù* — I'm not going.
- 我没去 — *wǒ méi qù* — I didn't go.
- 你有没有手机 — *nǐ yǒu méiyǒu shǒujī* — Do you have a phone?
- 没有 — *méiyǒu* — No, I don't.

Before you move on

Which negative says something did not happen? (没.) Which one says you won't? (不.) How do you ask whether somebody has a phone? (你有没有手机.)

87.4 chuáng — bed

Before the new one: the two negatives, then two words for home.

- *Recall:* say 我没去 — *wǒ méi qù*, I didn't go
- *Recall:* say *fángjiān*, a room — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *qǐchuáng*, to get up — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: chuáng

chuáng — "bed".

fángjiān lǐ yǒu chuáng ma — Is there a bed in the room?

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuáng is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzrjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a bed of slats'. It is the chuáng of *qǐchuáng*: to rise from the bed.

What you've built

fángjiān lǐ yǒu chuáng ma is 有 in its 'there is' job: the place first, then 有, then the thing. The answer is 有 or 没有.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuáng*
- *Say it: chuáng*, once more
- *Say it: fángjiān lǐ yǒu chuáng ma* — Is there a bed in the room?
- *Say it:* 没有 — *méiyǒu* — No, there isn't.

- *Recall:* say *qǐchuáng*, then *chuáng* again

Before you move on

What does *chuáng* mean? ("Bed".) Which word you know ends with it? (***qǐchuáng***, to get up.)

87.5 dēng — lamp; light

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the two verbs that go with this one.

- *Recall:* say *chuáng*, bed — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *kāi*, to switch on — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *guān*, to switch off — **R3**

You'll want to know: dēng

dēng — "lamp; light".

kāi dēng — Switch on the light.

guān dēng — Switch off the light.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēng is inherited from Middle Chinese *tong* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a lamp'.

What you've built

kāi and *guān* open and shut doors, and the same two verbs switch a light on and off.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēng*
- *Say it: dēng*, once more

- *Say it: kāi dēng* — Switch on the light.
- *Say it: guān dēng* — Switch off the light.
- *Recall:* say *chuáng*, then *dēng* again

Before you move on

What does *dēng* mean? (“Lamp; light”.) Switch it on. (*kāi dēng*.)

87.6 yàoshi — key

Before the new one: last lesson’s word, then two words for coming in.

- *Recall:* say *dēng*, a light — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 门 — *mén*, a door
- *Recall:* say 进 — *jìn*, to come in

You’ll want to know: yàoshi

yàoshi — “key”.

wǒ méiyǒu yàoshi — I don’t have a key.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yàoshi is built from two words inherited from Middle Chinese, *yak* and *dzye* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’a bolt’ and ’a spoon’. The Guangyun does not give the pair as ’key’, so how the two came together is not settled.

What you’ve built

wǒ méiyǒu yàoshi: 没有 in its ’not have’ job, with nothing between it and the thing.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàoshi*
- *Say it: yàoshi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ méiyǒu yàoshi* — I don't have a key.
- *Say it: mén*, then *yàoshi*
- *Recall:* say *dēng*, then *yàoshi* again

Before you move on

What does *yàoshi* mean? ("Key".) Say you don't have one. (*wǒ méiyǒu yàoshi.*)

87.7 bīngxiāng — fridge

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a drink, then a word for hurrying.

- *Recall:* say *yàoshi*, a key — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *niúnǎi*, milk — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say 马上 — *mǎshàng*, right away — **R2**

You'll want to know: bīngxiāng

bīngxiāng — "fridge; refrigerator".

bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu niúnǎi — There's milk in the fridge.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bīngxiāng is built from bīng 'ice' and xiāng 'a box', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ping* and *sjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'frozen water' and 'a box; a chest'. The pair names a machine the Guangyun never saw: the compound is modern.

What you've built

The place first, then 有, then the thing: *bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu niúnǎi.* The 里 after *bīngxiāng* is the one you write, and it means inside.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīngxiāng*
- *Say it: bīngxiāng*, once more
- *Say it: bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu niúnǎi* — There's milk in the fridge.
- *Say it: bīngxiāng lǐ méiyǒu shuǐ* — There's no water in the fridge.
- *Recall:* say *yàoshi* and *mǎshàng*, then *bīngxiāng* again

Before you move on

What does *bīngxiāng* mean? ("Fridge".) Say there is milk in it. (*bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu niúnǎi.*)

87.8 你有没有 — 没有

The chapter closes here, with a guest shown to a room.

- *Recall:* say *bīngxiāng*, a fridge — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *chídào*, to be late — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *láibují*, to run out of time — **R2**

The exchange

A: *zhè shì nǐ de fángjiān* — This is your room.

B: 谢谢

xièxie — Thanks.

B: *fángjiān lǐ yǒu dēng ma* — Is there a light in the room?

A: *yǒu, zài mén pángbiān* — Yes, by the door.

B: *nǐ yǒu méiyǒu yàoshi* — Have you got a key?

A: 没有

méiyǒu — No, I haven't.

A: *bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu niúnǎi* — There's milk in the fridge.

B: 我不喝

wǒ bù hē — I don't drink it.

Two kinds of no in one room: 没有, there isn't any, and 我不喝, I don't drink it. The first reports, the second refuses.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — four things, and what is missing

A bed, a light, a key and a fridge, and two ways to say a thing is not there:

- *nǐ yǒu méiyǒu yàoshi* — 没有 *méiyǒu*
- *fángjiān lǐ yǒu chuáng ma* — 没有 *méiyǒu*

Listen. *Nǐ yǒu méiyǒu shǒujī?*
Speak. Answer it with 有, then with 没有, then say what your room has.
Write it: 没 — 氵 first, then the small roof, then the crossing pair that opens 对

Your turn

- *Say it: nǐ yǒu méiyǒu yàoshi* — Have you got a key?
- *Say it:* 没有 — *méiyǒu* — No.
- *Say it: kāi dēng* — Switch on the light.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我没有手机

Before you move on

Say you don't have a phone. (我没有手机.) Say you didn't go. (我没去.) Say there is milk in the fridge. (*bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu niúnǎi*.)

Chapter 88

Two Cups of Tea

Modes: **voice** (7) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count things with 两 and the right measure word.
>
> *Counting things with* 两 *and four measure words beyond* 个*, and the tone* 一 *takes before each, built on one new written character:* 两*.*

88.1 两 (liǎng) — two of something

A new chapter, and it opens with a second word for two.

- *Recall:* say *nǐ yǒu méiyǒu yàoshi*, and answer *méiyǒu* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 一个人 — *yí ge rén*, one person
- *Recall:* say 二 — *èr*, two, as you count

You'll want to know: 两

两 — *liǎng* — "two (of something)".

> 两个人 *liǎng ge rén* — two people

The next lesson puts the new character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

两 (*liǎng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *ljangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where it names a weight and, quoting an older dictionary, 'twice'. 'Two of a thing' grew from those senses by a step the Guangyun does not show.

What you've built

Counting aloud, two is 二: *yī, èr, sān*. In front of a measure word it is 两: 两个人, two people. *èr ge rén* is not said.

Your turn

- *Say it: liǎng*
- *Say it: liǎng*, once more
- *Say it:* 两个人 — *liǎng ge rén* — two people
- *Say it:* 一 二 三 — *yī èr sān* — counting: one, two, three
- *Recall:* say *yí ge rén*, then *liǎng ge rén*

Before you move on

When is two 两? (**In front of a measure word:** 两个人.) And when is it 二? (**Counting: *yī, èr, sān***.)

88.2 两 — a bar, a frame, two small 人

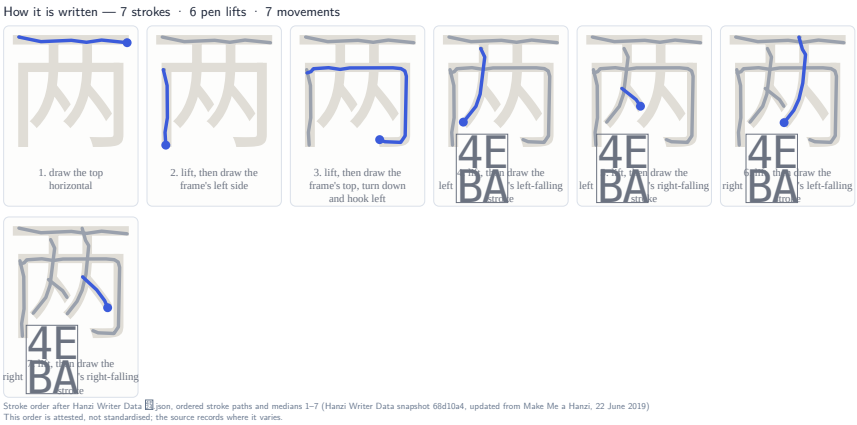
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *liǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

一 人

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yī*, *rén*

Script — a bar, a frame, two small 人



How 两 *is written, stroke by stroke*

两

A bar on top, then a frame, then what the frame holds.

The top bar, one stroke, across.

The frame, two strokes: a short vertical on the left, then a horizontal that turns down the right side and hooks to the left.

Two small 人, four strokes, the left one first: each a left-falling stroke and a short stroke falling to the right, rising through the top of the frame.

1 + 2 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 两, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 两? (**Seven**.) What does the frame hold? (**Two small 人**.) Which comes first, the frame or the two 人? (**The frame**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 两, pinned stroke paths and medians.

88.3 yī → yí ge, yì tiān: the tone 一 takes

Before the measure words, the sound that changes in front of them.

- *Read it:* 两个人, aloud — *liǎng ge rén*
- *Recall:* say 一百 — *yìbǎi*, a hundred
- *Recall:* say 一起 — *yìqǐ*, together

The sounds and tones in this word

一 has three spoken tones, and the next syllable picks one.
Counting, and inside numbers and dates, it stays level: *yī, èr, sān*; 星期一 *xīngqīyī*.
Before a fourth tone it rises: 一个 *yí ge*. 个 is fourth tone, even when it is said light.
Before the other three tones it falls: 一天 *yì tiān*, 一年 *yì nián*, 一百 *yìbǎi*.
This book writes the tone you say, as it writes *bú shì* for 不是.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *yī, èr, sān* — level
- 一个 — *yí ge* — rising, before a fourth tone
- 一天 — *yì tiān* — falling, before a first tone
- 一年 — *yì nián* — falling, before a second tone
- 一百 — *yìbǎi* — falling, before a third tone

Before you move on

What does 一 do before a fourth tone? (**It rises: *yí ge***.) Before the other tones? (**It falls: *yì tiān***.) And counting? (**It stays level: *yī***.)

88.4 bēi — a cup of, a glass of

Before the new one: the tone of 一, then two words that go with this one.

- *Recall:* say 一个 — *yí ge*, then 一天 — *yì tiān*
- *Recall:* say *chá*, tea — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *bēizi*, a cup — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: bēi

bēi — "a cup of; a glass of", a measure word.

liǎng bēi chá — two cups of tea

yì bēi shuǐ — a glass of water

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bēi is inherited from Middle Chinese *pwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed through an older book as a cup. It is the bēi of *bēizi*; as a measure word it counts what a cup holds.

What you've built

A measure word counts by the container: *liǎng bēi chá*, two cups' worth. 一 before its level tone falls: *yì bēi*.

Your turn

- *Say it: bēi*
- *Say it: bēi*, once more
- *Say it: liǎng bēi chá* — two cups of tea
- *Say it: yì bēi shuǐ* — a glass of water
- *Recall:* say *bēizi*, then *bēi* again

Before you move on

What does *bēi* count? (**Cups and glasses of something**.) Ask for two cups of tea. (*liǎng bēi chá*.)

88.5 běn — counting books

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the thing this one counts.

- *Recall:* say *liǎng bēi chá*, two cups of tea — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 书 — *shū*, a book

You'll want to know: běn

běn — a measure word for books.

yì běn shū — a book

wǒ yǒu liǎng běn shū — I have two books.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

běn is inherited from Middle Chinese *pwonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the root; the beginning'. Counting books with it is a later use the Guangyun does not record.

What you've built

个 counts almost anything; *běn* is the word a speaker reaches for with books. 一 before its dip falls: *yì běn*.

Your turn

- *Say it: běn*
- *Say it: běn*, once more
- *Say it: yì běn shū* — a book

- *Say it: wǒ yǒu liǎng běn shū* — I have two books.
- *Recall:* say *liǎng bēi chá*, then *liǎng běn shū*

Before you move on

What does *běn* count? (**Books**.) Say you have two. (*wǒ yǒu liǎng běn shū*.)

88.6 zhāng — counting flat things

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two flat things.

- *Recall:* say *yì běn shū*, a book — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *piào*, a ticket — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *chuáng*, a bed — **R1**, from the chapter before

You'll want to know: zhāng

zhāng — a measure word for flat things: tables, beds, tickets.

yì zhāng zhuōzi — a table

liǎng zhāng piào — two tickets

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhāng is inherited from Middle Chinese *trjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to stretch out; to spread'. Counting things that lie spread flat is a later use, not given there.

What you've built

A table, a bed, a ticket: things with a flat top or a flat face take *zhāng*.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhāng*
- *Say it: zhāng*, once more
- *Say it: liǎng zhāng piào* — two tickets
- *Say it: yì zhāng chuáng* — a bed
- *Recall:* say *yì běn shū*, then *yì zhāng zhuōzi*

Before you move on

What does *zhāng* count? (**Flat things: tables, beds, tickets**.)
Ask for two tickets. (*liǎng zhāng piào.*)

88.7 zhī — counting animals

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two animals.

- *Recall:* say *liǎng zhāng piào*, two tickets — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *māo*, a cat — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *gǒu*, a dog — **R3**

You'll want to know: zhī

zhī — a measure word for animals, and for one of a pair.

liǎng zhī māo — two cats

yì zhī shǒu — one hand

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhī is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'one'; the Guangyun, quoting an older dictionary, describes the old character as a hand holding a single bird.

What you've built

Cats, dogs, birds: animals take *zhī*. So does one of a pair, such as a hand: *yì zhī shǒu*.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhī*
- *Say it: zhī*, once more
- *Say it: liǎng zhī māo* — two cats
- *Say it: wǒ jiā yǒu yì zhī gǒu* — We have a dog at home.
- *Recall:* say *liǎng zhāng piào*, then *liǎng zhī māo*

Before you move on

What does *zhī* count? (**Animals, and one of a pair**.) Say two cats. (*liǎng zhī māo*.)

88.8 两个人

The chapter closes here, with two people looking for a table.

- *Recall:* say *liǎng zhī māo*, two cats — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *shàngbian*, on top — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *jǐ*, how many — **R4**, recognition at distance

The exchange

A: *nǐmen jǐ ge rén* — How many of you are there?

B: 两个人

liǎng ge rén — Two.

A: 你们喝什么

nǐmen hē shénme — What will you drink?

B: *liǎng bēi chá* — Two cups of tea.

A: *hǎo, nà zhāng zhuōzi* — Fine. That table, then.

B: *nàr yǒu liǎng zhī māo* — There are two cats there.

A: *zhuōzi shàngbian yǒu yì běn shū* — And there's a book on the table.

Every count has its measure word: 个 for people, *bēi* for tea, *zhāng* for the table, *zhī* for the cats, *běn* for the book. And every two is 两.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — a number, a measure word, a thing

Every count has three parts, in this order: the number, the measure word, the thing.

- 两个人 *liǎng ge rén* — two people
- *yì bēi shuǐ* — a glass of water
- *yì běn shū* — a book
- *liǎng zhāng piào* — two tickets
- *liǎng zhī māo* — two cats

Listen. *Nǐ yǒu jǐ běn shū?*
Speak. Count what is on your table, with the right measure word for each.
Write it: 两 — the bar, the frame, then the two small 人

Your turn

- *Say it:* 两个人 — *liǎng ge rén* — two people
- *Say it: liǎng bēi chá* — two cups of tea
- *Say it: yí ge, yì běn, yì zhāng, yì zhī* — and listen to 一 move

- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 两个人

Before you move on

Two people? (两个人.) Two cups of tea? (*liǎng bēi chá.*) A book? (*yì běn shū.*) Two cats? (*liǎng zhī māo.*)

Chapter 89

Give Me That

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name everyday actions: give, do, put, bring, stand.
>
> *Five everyday actions, give, do, put, bring and stand, and* 给我 *as a request, built on one new written character:* 给.

89.1 给 (gěi) — to give; to, for

A new chapter, and it opens with the verb that hands things over.

- *Recall:* say 两个人 — *liǎng ge rén*, two people
- *Recall:* say *liǎng zhī māo*, two cats — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *sòng*, to give as a present — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 给

给 — *gěi* — "to give; to, for".

> 妈妈给我一个手机 *māma gěi wǒ yí ge shǒujī* — Mum gives me a phone.
>
> 给我 *gěi wǒ* — Give it to me.

The next lesson puts the new character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

给 (*gěi*) is in the Guangyun as *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to supply'. That reading regularly gives jǐ, still heard in a few written words; how the everyday gěi came about is not settled.

What you've built

The person comes first, then the thing: 给, 我, 一个手机. On its own, 给我 is a request: give me. *sòng* gives a present; 给 gives anything at all.

Your turn

- *Say it: gěi*
- *Say it: gěi*, once more
- *Say it:* 妈妈给我一个手机 — *māma gěi wǒ yí ge shǒujī* — Mum gives me a phone.
- *Say it:* 给我 — *gěi wǒ* — Give it to me.
- *Recall:* say *sòng*, then *gěi* again

Before you move on

What does 给 mean? ("To give; to, for".) Which comes first after 给, the person or the thing? (**The person**.)

89.2 给 — the silk piece, then 合

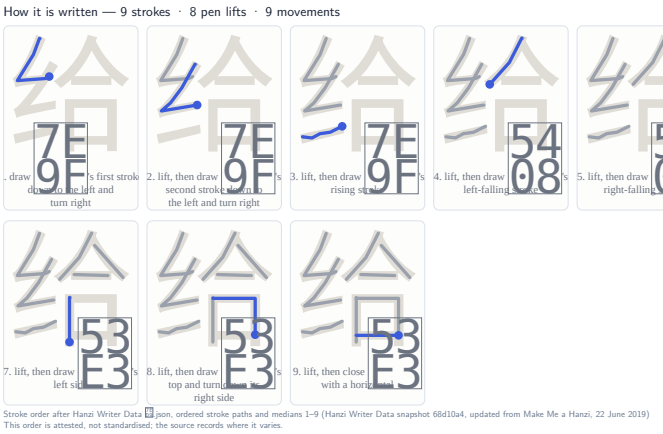
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gěi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

人 一 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *yī*, *kǒu*

Script — the silk piece, then 合



How 给 *is written, stroke by stroke*

给

Two pieces, left before right. The left piece is the one new shape.

The silk piece 纟, three strokes: a stroke that falls to the left and turns right, a second, longer one the same way, then a stroke rising to the right.

合, six strokes: a roof like 人, a left-falling stroke and a right-falling one; a short horizontal under it; then 口.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 给, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 给? (**Nine.**) Which piece is new? (**The silk piece, on the left.**) What sits at the foot of the right piece? (口.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 给, pinned stroke paths and medians.

89.3 做 (zuò) — to do; to make

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then a word you already write.

- *Read it:* 给你, aloud — *gěi nǐ*, here you are
- *Recall:* say 做饭 — *zuòfàn*, to cook
- *Recall:* say *wǒmen zuò chē qù*, we're going by car

You'll want to know: 做

做 — *zuò* — "to do; to make".

你做什么 *nǐ zuò shénme* — What are you doing?

妈妈做饭 *māma zuò fàn* — Mum cooks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

做 (*zuò*) has no reading in the Guangyun: no dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

You have written 做 since 做饭. *zuò* 'to sit', as in *zuò chē*, sounds the same and is a different word with a different character.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuò*
- *Say it: zuò*, once more
- *Say it:* 你做什么 — *nǐ zuò shénme* — What are you doing?
- *Say it:* 妈妈做饭 — *māma zuò fàn* — Mum cooks.
- *Recall:* say *zuò chē*, then 做饭, and hear the same sound twice

Before you move on

What does 做 mean? ("To do; to make".) Is it the *zuò* of *zuò chē*? (**No: same sound, another word**.)

89.4 fàng — to put; to place

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a bag and a table.

- *Recall:* say 你做什么 — *nǐ zuò shénme*
- *Recall:* say *bāo*, a bag — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *zhuōzi shàngbian*, on the table — **R2**

You'll want to know: fàng

fàng — "to put; to place".

fàng zài zhèr — Put it here.

fàng zài zhuōzi shàngbian — Put it on the table.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàng is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to drive out; to send away'. 'To put down' is a later sense the Guangyun does not give.

What you've built

fàng, then 在, then the place: the place words of the last two chapters all fit after it.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàng*
- *Say it: fàng*, once more
- *Say it: fàng zài zhèr* — Put it here.

- *Say it: fàng zài bāo lǐbian* — Put it in the bag.
- *Recall:* say *zuò*, then *fàng* again

Before you move on

What does *fàng* mean? ("To put; to place".) Put it here. (*fàng zài zhèr*.)

89.5 dài — to bring; to take along

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two things you take out with you.

- *Recall:* say *fàng zài zhèr*, put it here — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 手机 — *shǒujī*, a phone
- *Recall:* say *yàoshi*, a key

You'll want to know: dài

dài — "to bring; to take along".

nǐ dài shǒujī le ma — Have you brought your phone?

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dài is inherited from Middle Chinese *tajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a belt; a sash'. How a belt became 'to carry along' is not given there, so the step is not settled.

What you've built

nǐ dài shǒujī le ma: 了 after the verb says it is done, and 吗 makes the question. The answer is *dài le*, or *méi dài*.

Your turn

- *Say it: dài*
- *Say it: dài*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ dài shǒujī le ma* — Have you brought your phone?
- *Say it: méi dài* — No, I haven't.
- *Recall:* say *yàoshi*, then *dài* again

Before you move on

What does *dài* mean? ("To bring; to take along".) Say you didn't bring it. (*méi dài*.)

89.6 zhàn — to stand

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two places.

- *Recall:* say *dài*, to bring — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *huǒchēzhàn*, a railway station — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 门口 — *ménkǒu*, the doorway

You'll want to know: zhàn

zhàn — "to stand".

qǐng zhàn zài zhèr — Please stand here.

tā zhàn zài ménkǒu — He's standing in the doorway.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'in common speech, to stand alone'. The same word and character end *huǒchēzhàn*, a railway station.

What you've built

zhàn takes 在 and a place, as *fàng* does: *zhàn zài ménkǒu*, standing in the doorway.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhàn*
- *Say it: zhàn*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng zhàn zài zhèr* — Please stand here.
- *Say it: tā zhàn zài ménkǒu* — He's standing in the doorway.
- *Recall:* say *huǒchēzhàn*, then *zhàn* again

Before you move on

What does *zhàn* mean? ("To stand".) Where else have you heard it? (**At the end of *huǒchēzhàn***.)

89.7 给我

The chapter closes here, with somebody getting out of the door.

- *Recall:* say *zhàn*, to stand — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *zhǔnbèi*, to get ready — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *chūmén*, to go out — **R4**, recognition at distance

The exchange

A: 你做什么

nǐ zuò shénme — What are you doing?

B: *wǒ zhǔnbèi chūmén* — I'm getting ready to go out.

A: *nǐ dài yàoshi le ma* — Have you got your key?

B: *dài le. shǒujī ne* — Yes. Where's my phone?

A: *zài zhuōzi shàngbian. gěi nǐ* — On the table. Here you are.

B: *xièxie. fàng zài bāo lǐbian* — Thanks. In the bag it goes.

A: *qǐng zhàn zài ménkǒu, wǒ kànkan* — Stand in the doorway, let me look at you.

Five actions in one doorway: do, bring, give, put and stand. 给你, here you are, is 给 handing something over as it is said.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — five actions

Five verbs, and the three that take a place take it with 在:

- 给我 *gěi wǒ* — give it to me
- 你做什么 *nǐ zuò shénme* — what are you doing?
- *fàng zài zhèr* — put it here
- *nǐ dài shǒujī le ma* — have you brought your phone?
- *qǐng zhàn zài zhèr* — please stand here

Listen. *Gěi wǒ nǐ de shǒujī.*
Speak. Hand it over with 给你, then say where you put it.
Write it: 给 — the silk piece first, then the roof, the bar and 口

Your turn

- *Say it:* 给我 — *gěi wǒ* — Give it to me.
- *Say it:* 给你 — *gěi nǐ* — Here you are.
- *Say it: nǐ dài yàoshi le ma* — Have you got your key?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 给你

Before you move on

Hand something over. (**给你**.) Ask what somebody is doing. (**你做什么**.) Tell somebody to put it here. (*fàng zài zhèr*.) Ask whether they brought their key. (*nǐ dài yàoshi le ma*.)

Chapter 90

What I Can Do

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I can do and ask whether I may.
>
> *Three ways to say can:* 会 *for what you have learned,* 能 *for what you are able or allowed to do, kěyǐ for asking permission, built on one new written character:* 能.

90.1 会 (huì) — can, having learned how

A new chapter, and it opens with what you have learned to do.

- *Recall:* say 给你 — *gěi nǐ*, here you are
- *Recall:* say *qǐng zhàn zài zhèr*, please stand here — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *sījī*, a driver — **R2**

You'll want to know: 会

会 — *huì* — "can (having learned how)".

> 我会开车 *wǒ huì kāichē* — I can drive.
>
> 我会说汉语 *wǒ huì shuō Hànyǔ* — I can speak Chinese.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

会 (*huì*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to come together'. The sense 'can' is not given there, so how it got it is not settled.

What you've built

会 + a verb says you have learned to do it: driving, a language, a skill. A *sījī huì kāichē*: a driver can drive. You have written 会 since 一会儿; this is another word in the same character.

Your turn

- *Say it: huì*
- *Say it: huì*, once more
- *Say it:* 我会开车 — *wǒ huì kāichē* — I can drive.
- *Say it:* 我会说汉语 — *wǒ huì shuō Hànyǔ* — I can speak Chinese.
- *Recall:* say *sījī*, then say a driver can drive: *sījī huì kāichē*

Before you move on

What does 会 say? (**That you have learned how**.) Say you can drive. (我会开车.)

90.2 能 (néng) — can; able, allowed

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words about being ill.

- *Recall:* say 我会开车 — *wǒ huì kāichē*
- *Recall:* say *bìng*, to fall ill — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *yīshēng*, a doctor — **R2**

You'll want to know: 能

能 — *néng* — "can; to be able to; to be allowed to".

我能去吗 *wǒ néng qù ma* — Can I go?

wǒ bìng le, bù néng qù — I'm ill, I can't go.

The next lesson puts the new character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

能 (*néng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *nong* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'skilled; good at work'.

What you've built

会 is a skill you have learned. 能 is being able right now, or being allowed: you 会 drive, but ill you 不能.

Your turn

- *Say it: néng*
- *Say it: néng*, once more
- *Say it:* 我能去吗 — *wǒ néng qù ma* — Can I go?
- *Say it: wǒ bìng le, bù néng qù* — I'm ill, I can't go.
- *Recall:* say *yīshēng*, then *néng* again

Before you move on

What does 能 say? (**Able now, or allowed**.) And 会? (**Learned how**.)

90.3 能 — 厶 over the moon piece, then two 匕

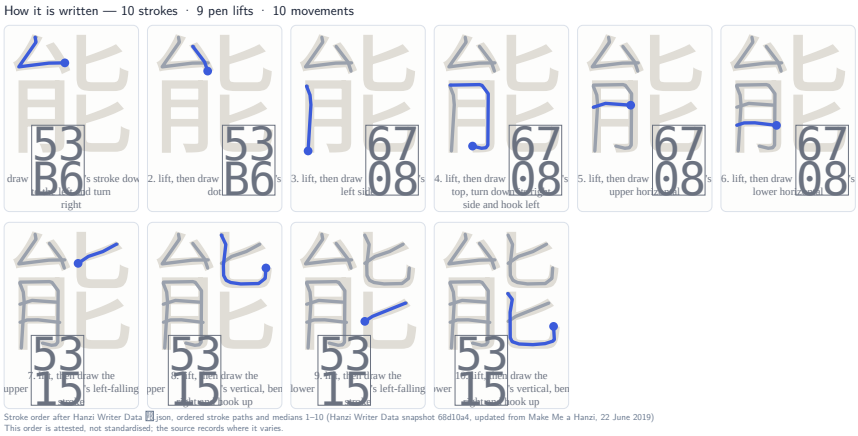
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *néng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

明 前

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *míng*, *qián*

Script — 厶 over the moon piece, then two 匕



How 能 *is written, stroke by stroke*

能

The whole left side first, top to bottom, then the right.

厶, two strokes: a stroke that falls to the left and turns right, then a dot.

The moon piece 月, four strokes, as it stands in 明 and 前: the left side, the top that turns down and hooks, two short bars inside.

Two 匕, two strokes each, the upper one first: a short left-falling stroke, then a vertical that bends right along its foot and hooks up.

2 + 4 + 4 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 能, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 能? (**Ten.**) Which piece do you know from 明? (**The moon piece, 月.**) Which side is written first? (**The left, all of it.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 能, pinned stroke paths and medians.

90.4 kěyǐ — may; can, with permission

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then two words you will need with this one.

- *Read it:* 我能去吗, aloud — *wǒ néng qù ma*
- *Recall:* say *zuò*, to sit — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *gōngrén*, a worker — **R2**

You'll want to know: kěyǐ

kěyǐ — "may; can (with permission)".

wǒ kěyǐ zuò zhèr ma — May I sit here?

Two dips in a row: spoken, the first one rises, *kéyǐ*. It is written *kěyǐ*. Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kěyǐ is built from kě 'may' and yǐ 'to use', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *yiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to permit' and 'to use'.

What you've built

会 learned, 能 able or allowed, *kěyǐ* permitted. Asking whether you may, *kěyǐ* is the polite one; the answer is *kěyǐ*, or *bù kěyǐ*.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěyǐ* — and hear it as *kéyǐ*
- *Say it: kěyǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ kěyǐ zuò zhèr ma* — May I sit here?
- *Say it: kěyǐ* — yes, you may
- *Recall:* say *gōngrén*, then *kěyǐ* again

Before you move on

What does *kěyǐ* ask? (**Whether you may**.) How is it said? (***kéyǐ***, the first dip rising.)

90.5 yóuyǒng — to swim

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two kinds of exercise.

- *Recall:* say *kěyǐ*, may — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *yùndòng*, sport — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *pǎobù*, to run — **R4**

You'll want to know: yóuyǒng

yóuyǒng — "to swim".

nǐ huì yóuyǒng ma — Can you swim?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóuyǒng is built from yóu 'to float' and yǒng 'to swim under water', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *hjwaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). *hjwaengH* would regularly give yòng, with a fall; why the modern word dips is not settled.

What you've built

Swimming is learned, so it takes 会: *nǐ huì yóuyǒng ma.* 能 asks whether you are able today: *jīntiān nǐ néng yóuyǒng ma.*

Your turn

- *Say it: yóuyǒng*
- *Say it: yóuyǒng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ huì yóuyǒng ma* — Can you swim?
- *Say it: wǒ bú huì yóuyǒng* — I can't swim.

- *Recall:* say *pǎobù*, then *yóuyǒng* again

Before you move on

What does *yóuyǒng* mean? ("To swim".) Which can goes with it, 会 or 能? (**会, a skill you learn**.)

90.6 我会开车

The chapter closes here, with three ways to say can in one conversation.

- *Recall:* say *yóuyǒng*, to swim — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *shàngbān*, to go to work — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *gōngsī*, a company — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你会开车吗

nǐ huì kāichē ma — Can you drive?

B: 会

huì — I can.

A: 你明天能开车吗

nǐ míngtiān néng kāichē ma — Can you drive tomorrow?

B: *bù néng, wǒ míngtiān shàngbān* — No, I'm at work tomorrow.

A: *nǐ huì yóuyǒng ma* — Can you swim?

B: 不会

bú huì — I can't.

A: *wǒ kěyǐ zuò zhèr ma* — May I sit here?

B: *kěyǐ* — Yes, please.

The answer to each is the verb alone: 会, 不能, 不会, *kěyǐ*. Mandarin answers yes or no by saying the verb again.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — three cans

- 我会开车 *wǒ huì kāichē* — I have learned to drive.
- 我明天不能开车 *wǒ míngtiān bù néng kāichē* — tomorrow I'm not able to.
- *wǒ kěyǐ zuò zhèr ma* — may I sit here?

Listen. *Nǐ huì shuō Hànyǔ ma?*
Speak. Answer it, then say one thing you cannot do today, and ask permission for something.
Write it: 能 — the whole left side first, then the two hooked pieces on the right

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你会开车吗 — *nǐ huì kāichē ma* — Can you drive?
- *Say it:* 你明天能开车吗 — *nǐ míngtiān néng kāichē ma* — Can you drive tomorrow?
- *Say it: wǒ kěyǐ zuò zhèr ma* — May I sit here?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我能去吗

Before you move on

Say you can drive. (我会开车.) Ask whether you can go. (我能去吗.) Ask whether you may sit here. (*wǒ kěyǐ zuò zhèr ma.*) Which can is a skill? (会.)

Chapter 91

What I'd Like

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I want and what I do not want.
>
> *Saying what you would like, what you need and what you do not want, and asking for a little, built on one new written character:* 要.

91.1 想要 (xiǎngyào) — to want; would like

A new chapter, and it opens with a word for wanting, softer than the one you know.

- *Recall:* say 我会开车 — *wǒ huì kāichē*
- *Recall:* say *nǐ huì yóuyǒng ma*, can you swim — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *wǒ yào zhège*, I want this one — **R4**, from the chapter on money
- *Recall:* say 我想去 — *wǒ xiǎng qù*, I'd like to go

You'll want to know: 想要

想要 — *xiǎngyào* — "to want; would like".

> 我想要一个手机 *wǒ xiǎngyào yí ge shǒujī* — I'd like a phone.

The next lesson puts the second character in your hand: it is the *yào* you have said since the chapter on money.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

想要 (*xiǎngyào*) is built from 想 'to think of; to want to' and *yào* 'to want', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjangX* and *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to think' and 'to bind by agreement'. 'To want' is not given there for *yào*, so how it got that sense is not settled.

What you've built

想 + a verb: you would like to do it, 我想去. *yào* + a thing: you want it. 想要 + a thing says the same as *yào*, more gently.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎngyào*
- *Say it: xiǎngyào*, once more
- *Say it:* 我想要一个手机 — *wǒ xiǎngyào yí ge shǒujī* — I'd like a phone.
- *Say it:* 我想去 — *wǒ xiǎng qù* — I'd like to go.
- *Recall:* say *wǒ yào zhège*, then say it more gently with 想要

Before you move on

What does 想要 take, a thing or a verb? (**A thing:** 想要一个手机.) And 想 alone? (**A verb:** 我想去.)

91.2 要 — the top of 西, then 女

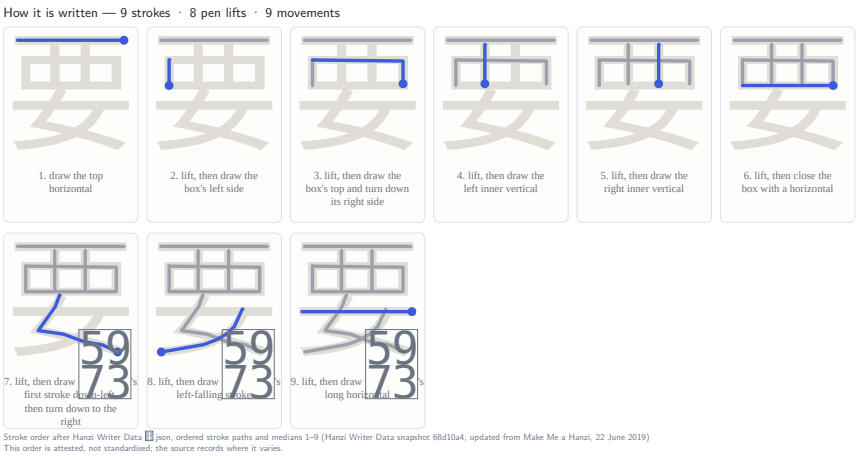
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiǎngyào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

女 妈

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǚ*, *mā*

Script — the top of 西, then 女



How 要 is written, stroke by stroke

要

Two pieces, top before bottom, and the bottom one you have written since 好.

覀, six strokes: the top bar; then a box, its left side and its top turning down the right side; two short verticals inside it; then the bar that closes the box.

女, three strokes, wide under it: the stroke that falls left and turns down to the right, the left-falling stroke, then the long bar.

6 + 3 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 要, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 要? (**Nine**.) Which character you know sits at the foot? (女.) When is the box closed? (**Before 女 begins**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 要, pinned stroke paths and medians.

91.3 不要 (bú yào) — don't; do not want

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then two words with the same rising 不.

- *Read it:* 我想要, aloud — *wǒ xiǎngyào*
- *Recall:* say 不是 — *bú shì*
- *Recall:* say 不客气 — *bú kèqi*, you're welcome

You'll want to know: 不要

不要 — *bú yào* — "don't; do not want".

我不要 *wǒ bú yào* — I don't want it.

不要说 *bú yào shuō* — Don't say it.

不 before the fall of 要 rises: *bú yào*, as in *bú shì*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不要 (*bú yào*) is built from 不 'not' and 要 'to want', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

Two jobs. 我不要: I don't want it. 不要 + a verb: don't do it. The second is how Mandarin tells somebody not to.

Your turn

- *Say it: bú yào*
- *Say it: bú yào*, once more
- *Say it:* 我不要 — *wǒ bú yào* — I don't want it.
- *Say it:* 不要说 — *bú yào shuō* — Don't say it.
- *Recall:* say *bú kèqi*, then *bú yào*, and hear the same rise

Before you move on

What are the two jobs of 不要? (**I don't want it, and don't do it**.) Which tone does 不 take here? (**It rises: *bú***.)

91.4 xūyào — to need

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two things a tired person needs.

- *Recall:* say 不要说 — *bú yào shuō*, don't say it
- *Recall:* say *xiūxi*, to rest — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *bāngmáng*, to help out — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: xūyào

xūyào — "to need".

wǒ xūyào xiūxi — I need a rest.

nǐ xūyào bāngmáng ma — Do you need a hand?

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xūyào is built from xū and yào 'to want', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sju* and *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun glosses *sju* only as the name of a hexagram, so 'to need' is not given there.

What you've built

想要 is what you would like; *xūyào* is what you cannot do without.

Your turn

- *Say it: xūyào*
- *Say it: xūyào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xūyào xiūxi* — I need a rest.

- *Say it: nǐ xūyào bāngmáng ma* — Do you need a hand?
- *Recall:* say *xiūxi*, then *xūyào* again

Before you move on

What does *xūyào* mean? ("To need".) Which is softer, *xūyào* or 想要? (**想要, what you would like.**)

91.5 一点儿 (yìdiǎnr) — a little

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then water, then the tone of 一.

- *Recall:* say *xūyào*, to need — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 水 — *shuǐ*, water
- *Recall:* say 一天 — *yì tiān*, a day, with 一 falling

You'll want to know: 一点儿

一点儿 — *yìdiǎnr* — "a little; a bit".

我要一点儿水 *wǒ yào yìdiǎnr shuǐ* — I'd like a little water.

一 before the dip of 点 falls: *yì*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一点儿 (*yìdiǎnr*) is built from 一 'one', 点 'a dot' and the r ending 儿: a dot's worth. 一 and 点 are inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *temX* glossed 'a dot; a stroke of the brush'.

What you've built

一点儿 goes after the verb and before the thing: 要, 一点儿, 水.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìdiǎnr*
- *Say it: yìdiǎnr*, once more
- *Say it:* 我要一点儿水 — *wǒ yào yìdiǎnr shuǐ* — I'd like a little water.
- *Say it:* 我想要一点儿 — *wǒ xiǎngyào yìdiǎnr* — I'd like a little.
- *Recall:* say *xūyào*, then *yìdiǎnr* again

Before you move on

What does 一点儿 mean? ("A little".) Where does it go? (**After the verb, before the thing**.)

91.6 我想要一点儿水

The chapter closes here, with a host and a guest.

- *Recall:* say *yìdiǎnr*, a little — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *chá*, tea — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *lèi*, tired — **R4**

The exchange

A: 你想喝什么

nǐ xiǎng hē shénme — What would you like to drink?

B: 我想要一点儿水

wǒ xiǎngyào yìdiǎnr shuǐ — I'd like a little water.

A: *nǐ yào chá ma* — Would you like tea?

B: 不要 谢谢

bú yào, xièxie — No, thank you.

A: *nǐ xūyào xiūxi ma* — Do you need a rest?

B: *bù, wǒ bú lèi* — No, I'm not tired.

Four ways of wanting: 想 + a verb, 想要 + a thing, *yào* + a thing, *xūyào* for a need. And one way of refusing that is still polite: 不要, 谢谢.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — wanting, needing, refusing

- 我想要一点儿水 *wǒ xiǎngyào yìdiǎnr shuǐ* — I'd like a little water.
- 我要这个 *wǒ yào zhège* — I want this one.
- *wǒ xūyào xiūxi* — I need a rest.
- 不要 谢谢 *bú yào, xièxie* — no, thank you.

Listen. *Nǐ yào shénme?*
Speak. Ask for a little of something, then turn something down politely.
Write it: 要 — the box under its bar first, then 女

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我想要一点儿水 — *wǒ xiǎngyào yìdiǎnr shuǐ* — I'd like a little water.
- *Say it:* 不要 谢谢 — *bú yào, xièxie* — No, thank you.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我要一点儿水

Before you move on

Ask for a little water. (我要一点儿水.) Turn down tea politely. (不要 谢谢.) Say you need a rest. (*wǒ xūyào xiūxi.*)

Chapter 92

Me Too

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can order at a table and say 'me too'.
>
> *Ordering at a table, the menu, the waiter and anything else, and 'me too' with 也, built on one new written character: 也.*

92.1 也 (yě) — also; too

A new chapter, and it opens with the word you need when somebody else has ordered first.

- *Recall:* say 我想要一点儿水 — *wǒ xiǎngyào yìdiǎnr shuǐ*
- *Recall:* say 一点儿 — *yìdiǎnr*, a little
- *Recall:* say 他是学生 — *tā shì xuésheng*, he's a student

You'll want to know: 也

也 — *yě* — "also; too".

> 我也要 *wǒ yě yào* — Me too; I'd like one too.
>
> 他也是学生 *tā yě shì xuésheng* — He's a student too.

The next lesson puts the character in your hand. You have written it before, as the right half of 他.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

也 (*yě*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *yaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a particle that closes a sentence'. 'Also' is not given there, so how it came to mean 'also' is not settled.

What you've built

也 goes in front of the verb: 我也要, 他也是学生. English puts *too* at the end; Mandarin does not.

Your turn

- *Say it: yě*
- *Say it: yě*, once more
- *Say it:* 我也要 — *wǒ yě yào* — Me too.
- *Say it:* 他也是学生 — *tā yě shì xuésheng* — He's a student too.
- *Recall:* say *wǒ xiǎngyào yìdiǎnr shuǐ*, then answer it for yourself with 我也要

Before you move on

What does 也 mean? ("Also; too".) Where does it go? (**In front of the verb:** 我也要.)

92.2 也 — the right half of 他

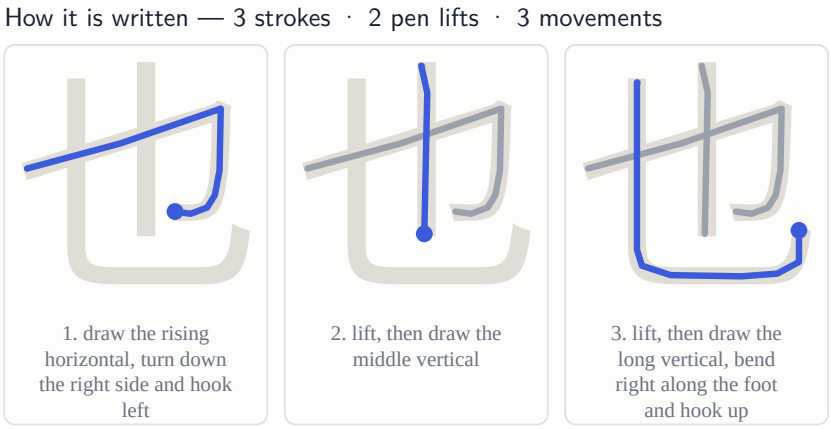
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yě* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  他 他们

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tā*, *tāmen*

Script — the right half of 他



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 也.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 也 is written, stroke by stroke

也

One piece, and your hand already knows it: the right half of 他, stroke for stroke.

A hooked turn: a horizontal that rises a little, turns down the right side and hooks to the left.

A short vertical from above it, down through it.

The long bend: down the left from above the horizontal, along the foot to the right, and a hook up at the end.

Three strokes.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 也, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 也? (**Three**.) Where have you written them before? (**On the right of 他**.) Which stroke ends with a hook up? (**The last, the long bend**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 也, pinned stroke paths and medians.

92.3 càidān — menu

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then two words for food.

- *Read it:* 我也要, aloud — *wǒ yě yào*
- *Recall:* say *cài*, a dish — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *diǎncài*, to order food — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: càidān

càidān — "menu".

qǐng gěi wǒ càidān — The menu, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

càidān is built from cài 'a dish', the *cài* you know, and dān, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshojH* and *tan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'greens fit to eat' and 'single'. A sheet that lists the dishes is the modern sense of the pair.

What you've built

qǐng gěi wǒ càidān: 请, then 给 + the person + the thing, the pattern of the chapter on giving.

Your turn

- *Say it: càidān*
- *Say it: càidān*, once more

- *Say it: qǐng gěi wǒ càidān* — The menu, please.
- *Recall:* say *diǎncài*, then *càidān* again

Before you move on

What does *càidān* mean? (“Menu”.) Ask for it. (*qǐng gěi wǒ càidān.*)

92.4 fúwùyuán — waiter; attendant

Before the new one: last lesson’s word, then a place to eat, then a guest.

- *Recall:* say *càidān*, the menu — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *fàndiàn*, a restaurant — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say 客人 — *kèrén*, a guest

You’ll want to know: fúwùyuán

fúwùyuán — “waiter; attendant”.

fúwùyuán, wǒ yào càidān — Excuse me, the menu, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fúwùyuán is built from fú ’to serve’, wù ’a task’ and yuán, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuwk*, *mjuH* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’to serve’, ’affairs’ and ’a number of things’. ’A member of staff’ is a later sense of yuán.

What you’ve built

In a restaurant or a shop, *fúwùyuán* is also how you call the person serving: say it, then what you want.

Your turn

- *Say it: fúwùyuán*
- *Say it: fúwùyuán*, once more
- *Say it: fúwùyuán, wǒ yào càidān* — Excuse me, the menu, please.
- *Recall:* say *fàndiàn*, then *fúwùyuán* again

Before you move on

What does *fúwùyuán* mean? ("Waiter; attendant".) Call one and ask for the menu. (*fúwùyuán, wǒ yào càidān.*)

92.5 biéde — something else; other

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the particle at the end of this one.

- *Recall:* say *fúwùyuán*, a waiter — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *dōngxi*, things — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say 我的书 — *wǒ de shū*, my book

You'll want to know: biéde

biéde — "something else; other".

nǐ yào biéde ma — Would you like anything else?

wǒ xiǎngyào biéde dōngxi — I'd like something else.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biéde is built from bié 'other; apart' and de, the 的 you write. bié is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'different; to part'; where de comes from is not settled.

What you've built

nǐ yào biéde ma is the waiter's question; *bú yào, xièxie* is the answer when you have all you need.

Your turn

- *Say it: biéde*
- *Say it: biéde*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yào biéde ma* — Would you like anything else?
- *Say it:* 不要 谢谢 — *bú yào, xièxie* — No, thank you.
- *Recall:* say *dōngxi*, then *biéde* again

Before you move on

What does *biéde* mean? ("Something else; other".) Answer the waiter's question politely. (不要 谢谢.)

92.6 我也要

The chapter closes here, at a table for two.

- *Recall:* say *biéde*, something else — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *jiǎozi*, dumplings — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *xūyào*, to need — **R2**

The exchange

A: *fúwùyuán, qǐng gěi wǒmen càidān* — Excuse me, could we have the menu?

B: 好 你们喝什么

hǎo, nǐmen hē shénme — Of course. What will you drink?

A: 我要水

wǒ yào shuǐ — Water for me.

C: 我也要

wǒ yě yào — Me too.

B: *nǐmen yào biéde ma* — Anything else?

A: *wǒ yào jiǎozi* — Dumplings for me.

C: *wǒ yě yào jiǎozi* — Dumplings for me too.

B: 好

hǎo — Right you are.

Ordering is *yào* and the thing; agreeing is 也 in front of it. Nobody says *I* would like: 我要 does the job.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — ordering at a table

- *qǐng gěi wǒmen càidān* — the menu, please.
- 我要水 *wǒ yào shuǐ* — water for me.
- 我也要 *wǒ yě yào* — me too.
- *nǐmen yào biéde ma* — anything else?

Listen. *Nǐmen hē shénme?*
Speak. Order a drink, then agree with somebody else's order using 也.
Write it: 也 — the hooked turn, the short vertical, the long bend

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我也要 — *wǒ yě yào* — Me too.
- *Say it:* 请给我们水 — *qǐng gěi wǒmen shuǐ* — Water for us, please.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, every part
- *Write it:* 我也要

Before you move on

Say me too. (我也要.) Ask for the menu. (*qǐng gěi wǒ càidān.*) Call the waiter. (*fúwùyuán.*) Where does 也 go? (**In front of the verb**.)

Chapter 93

Too Much

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say something is too much, or a bit too much.
>
> *Too much with* 太 … 了*, a bit too much with* 有点儿*, great with* 太好了*, and clean and dirty, built on one new written character:* 太*.*

93.1 太好了 (tài hǎo le) — great!

A new chapter, and it opens with a sound you have made since the chapter on money.

- *Recall:* say 我也要 — *wǒ yě yào*, me too
- *Recall:* say *nǐ yào biéde ma*, anything else — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *tài guì le*, too expensive — **R4**, from the chapter on money

You'll want to know: 太好了

太好了 — *tài hǎo le* — "great!; that's wonderful".

> 我们明天去 太好了 *wǒmen míngtiān qù, tài hǎo le* — We're going tomorrow? Great!

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. It is the *tài* you have said since *tài guì le*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

太好了 (*tài hǎo le*) is built from 太 'too; extremely', 好 'good' and 了. 太 and 好 are inherited from Middle Chinese, *thajH* and *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *thajH* glossed 'extreme; great'.

What you've built

tài … le around an adjective says too much: *tài guì le*, too expensive. Around 好 it is not 'too good'. It is the everyday 'great!'

Your turn

- *Say it: tài hǎo le*
- *Say it: tài hǎo le*, once more, as if you meant it
- *Say it:* 我们明天去 太好了 — *wǒmen míngtiān qù, tài hǎo le* — We're going tomorrow? Great!
- *Recall:* say *tài guì le*, then *tài hǎo le*, and hear one complaint and one delight

Before you move on

What does 太好了 mean? ("Great!".) Is it 'too good'? (**No: *tài … le* around 好 is plain delight**.)

93.2 太 — 大, then a dot

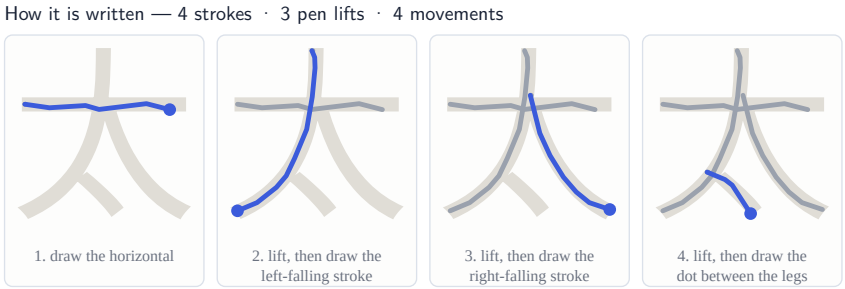
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tài hǎo le* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  大 天

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *tiān*

Script — 大, then a dot



How 太 is written, stroke by stroke

太

大 with one stroke added, and the added stroke comes last.

大, three strokes: the bar, the left-falling stroke through it, the right-falling stroke from the crossing.

One dot, between the two legs.

3 + 1 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 太, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 太? (**Four**.) Which character is inside it? (大.) Where does the dot go? (**Between the legs, last**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 太, pinned stroke paths and medians.

93.3 有点儿 (yǒudiǎnr) — a bit, and not in a good way

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then two words this one is made from.

- *Read it:* 太好了, aloud — *tài hǎo le*
- *Recall:* say 一点儿 — *yìdiǎnr*, a little
- *Recall:* say *lěng*, cold — **R4**, recognition at distance

You'll want to know: 有点儿

有点儿 — *yǒudiǎnr* — "a bit (of something unwanted); rather".

有点儿大 *yǒudiǎnr dà* — It's a bit big.

太大了 *tài dà le* — It's too big.

Two dips in a row: spoken, the first rises, *yóudiǎnr*. It is written *yǒudiǎnr*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

有点儿 (*yǒudiǎnr*) is built from 有 'to have', 点 'a dot' and the r ending: having a dot of it. 有 and 点 are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

有点儿 + an adjective is a mild complaint: *yǒudiǎnr lěng*, it's a bit cold. 很 is neutral; 太 … 了 is strong. And 一点儿 is a different job: it goes after a verb, 要一点儿水.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yǒudiǎnr* — and hear it as *yóudiǎnr*
- *Say it:* 有点儿大 — *yǒudiǎnr dà* — It's a bit big.
- *Say it:* 太大了 — *tài dà le* — It's too big.
- *Say it:* *yǒudiǎnr lěng* — It's a bit cold.
- *Recall:* say *yào yìdiǎnr shuǐ*, then *yǒudiǎnr dà*, and hear the two jobs

Before you move on

What does 有点儿 say about an adjective? (**A bit, and not welcome.**) Which is stronger, 有点儿大 or 太大了? (太大了.)

93.4 gānjìng — clean

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a room, then 很.

- *Recall:* say 有点儿大 — *yǒudiǎnr dà*
- *Recall:* say *fángjiān*, a room — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 很好 — *hěn hǎo*, fine

You'll want to know: gānjìng

gānjìng — "clean".

fángjiān hěn gānjìng — The room is clean.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gānjìng is built from gān 'dry' and jìng, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kan* and *dzjengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'dry' and 'without dirt'.

What you've built

An adjective takes a plain 很 where English has *is*: *fángjiān hěn gānjìng*. No 是.

Your turn

- *Say it: gānjìng*
- *Say it: gānjìng*, once more
- *Say it: fángjiān hěn gānjìng* — The room is clean.
- *Say it: fángjiān bù gānjìng* — The room isn't clean.
- *Recall:* say *yǒudiǎnr dà*, then *gānjìng* again

Before you move on

What does *gānjìng* mean? (“Clean”.) What goes in front of it, 是 or 很? (很.)

93.5 zāng — dirty

Before the new one: last lesson’s word, then two things that get dirty.

- *Recall:* say *gānjìng*, clean — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *xié*, shoes — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *yīfu*, clothes — **R3**

You’ll want to know: zāng

zāng — “dirty”.

xié tài zāng le — The shoes are too dirty.

yīfu yǒudiǎnr zāng — The clothes are a bit dirty.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

The older character for *zāng* is in the Guangyun as *tsangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), but only inside a two-character word for a sturdy body, and that reading would give zǎng, not zāng. No dictionary we use records the word ’dirty’ in an older form, so the history of *zāng* is not settled.

What you’ve built

gānjìng and *zāng*, clean and dirty, and three strengths for each: 很, 有点儿, 太 … 了.

Your turn

- *Say it: zāng*

- *Say it: zāng*, once more
- *Say it: xié tài zāng le* — The shoes are too dirty.
- *Say it: yīfu yǒudiǎnr zāng* — The clothes are a bit dirty.
- *Recall:* say *gānjìng*, then *zāng* again

Before you move on

What does *zāng* mean? ("Dirty".) Say the shoes are too dirty. (*xié tài zāng le.*)

93.6 太大了

The chapter closes here, with two people shopping and not finding it.

- *Recall:* say *zāng*, dirty — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *zěnmeyàng*, how is it — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *piányi*, cheap — **R4**

The exchange

A: *zhège zěnmeyàng* — How's this one?

B: 太大了

tài dà le — Too big.

A: 那个呢

nàge ne — And that one?

B: 有点儿小

yǒudiǎnr xiǎo — A bit small.

A: 这个很好看

zhège hěn hǎokàn — This one's nice.

B: *yǒudiǎnr zāng* — It's a bit dirty.

A: 我们去吃饭

wǒmen qù chī fàn — Let's go and eat, then.

B: 太好了

tài hǎo le — Great!

Three strengths of complaint, 有点儿, 很 and 太 … 了, and one delight to finish: 太好了.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — three strengths

- 很大 *hěn dà* — big; a plain statement.
- 有点儿大 *yǒudiǎnr dà* — a bit big, and I'd rather it wasn't.
- 太大了 *tài dà le* — too big.
- 太好了 *tài hǎo le* — great!

Listen. *Fángjiān zěnmeyàng?*
Speak. Answer it three ways: *gānjìng*, a bit dirty, too dirty.
Write it: 太 — 大, then the dot

Your turn

- *Say it:* 太大了 — *tài dà le* — Too big.
- *Say it:* 有点儿小 — *yǒudiǎnr xiǎo* — A bit small.
- *Say it: fángjiān hěn gānjìng* — The room is clean.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 太好了

Before you move on

Say it is too big. (太大了.) Say it is a bit small. (有点儿小.) Say great. (太好了.) Say the room is clean. (*fángjiān hěn gānjìng.*)

Chapter 94

All the Same

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe people and things, and say 'all of them'.
>
> *Describing people, young, fat, thin, the same or not, and saying all of them with* **都**, *built on one new written character:* **都**.

94.1 都 (dōu) — all; both

A new chapter, and it opens with the word that gathers people together.

- *Recall:* say 太大了 — *tài dà le*, too big
- *Recall:* say *xié tài zāng le*, the shoes are too dirty — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 大家 — *dàjiā*, everyone

You'll want to know: 都

都 — *dōu* — "all; both".

我们都是学生 *wǒmen dōu shì xuésheng* — We're all students.

他们都很好 *tāmen dōu hěn hǎo* — They're all fine.

The next lesson puts the new character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

都 (*dōu*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'all together', and also 'a capital city', the sense said dū today. The regular change from *tu* gives dū; why the word for 'all' is said dōu is not settled.

What you've built

都 goes in front of the verb or the adjective and looks back at the people before it: 我们都, all of us. With two people it means both.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōu*
- *Say it: dōu*, once more
- *Say it:* 我们都是学生 — *wǒmen dōu shì xuésheng* — We're all students.
- *Say it:* 他们都很好 — *tāmen dōu hěn hǎo* — They're all fine.
- *Recall:* say *dàjiā*, then *dōu* again

Before you move on

What does 都 mean? ("All; both".) Where does it go? (**In front of the verb, after the people**.)

94.2 都 — 者, then the ear on the right

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dōu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 那 在

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *nà*, *zài*

Script — 者, then the ear on the right

How 都 *is written, stroke by stroke*

都

Two pieces, left before right, and every stroke in them is one you have made.

者, eight strokes: first the foot of 在, a short bar, a vertical through it, then the long bar; then a long left-falling stroke from the upper right; then 日 under them.

The ear piece, two strokes, on the right, as 那 ends: across, back, round and hooking; then the long vertical.

8 + 2 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 都, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 都? (**Ten.**) Which character ends the left piece? (日.) Where have you written the ear piece? (**On the right of 那.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 都, pinned stroke paths and medians.

94.3 yíyàng — the same

Before the new one: read a line with two characters you have written in the last two chapters, then the tone of 一.

- *Read it:* 他们也都很好, aloud — *tāmen yě dōu hěn hǎo*, they're all fine too
- *Recall:* say 一个 — *yí ge*, with 一 rising

You'll want to know: yíyàng

yíyàng — "the same; alike".

wǒmen bù yíyàng — We're not the same.

wǒmen yíyàng dà — We're the same age.

一 before the fall of yàng rises: *yí*. Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yíyàng is built from yī 'one' and yàng 'a pattern; a kind': one pattern. yī is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); yàng has no reading in the Guangyun, so no dictionary we use records an older form of it, and its history is not settled.

What you've built

In *tāmen yě dōu hěn hǎo*, 也 comes before 都: too, and all of them. *yíyàng* + an adjective says how two things match: *yíyàng dà*, the same size or the same age.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíyàng*
- *Say it: yíyàng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen bù yíyàng* — We're not the same.
- *Say it: wǒmen yíyàng dà* — We're the same age.
- *Recall:* say *yí ge*, then *yíyàng*, and hear the same rise

Before you move on

What does *yíyàng* mean? (“The same”.) Which comes first, 也 or 都? (也: 也都.)

94.4 niánqīng — young

Before the new one: last lesson’s word, then two words about age and people.

- *Recall:* say *yíyàng*, the same — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *niánjì*, age — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *lǎoshī*, a teacher — **R4**, recognition at distance

You’ll want to know: niánqīng

niánqīng — “young”.

wǒ de lǎoshī hěn niánqīng — My teacher is very young.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niánqīng is built from nián ’year’, the 年 you write, and qīng ’light’, not heavy: light in years. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *nen* and *khjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), *khjieng* glossed ’light in weight’.

What you’ve built

niánqīng is said of grown people; a child is *xiǎo*. *lǎo*, old, is its opposite.

Your turn

- *Say it: niánqīng*
- *Say it: niánqīng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de lǎoshī hěn niánqīng* — My teacher is very young.
- *Recall:* say *niánjì*, then *niánqīng* again

Before you move on

What does *niánqīng* mean? (“Young”.) Which written character does it open with? (年.)

94.5 pàng — fat; plump

Before the new one: last lesson’s word, then an animal and something to eat.

- *Recall:* say *niánqīng*, young — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *māo*, a cat — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *dàngāo*, a cake — **R2**

You’ll want to know: pàng

pàng — “fat; plump”.

māo tài pàng le — The cat’s too fat.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

The character for *pàng* is in the Guangyun as *phanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’half of a sacrificial animal’. That reading would give pàn, not pàng, and the sense is not ’fat’, so the history of *pàng* is not settled.

What you’ve built

pàng is a word for people and animals, and said of a person it is blunt: a cat can hear *tài pàng le* without offence.

Your turn

- *Say it: pàng*
- *Say it: pàng*, once more
- *Say it: māo tài pàng le* — The cat’s too fat.

- *Say it: māo yǒudiǎnr pàng* — The cat's a bit plump.
- *Recall:* say *dàngāo*, then *pàng* again

Before you move on

What does *pàng* mean? ("Fat; plump".) Say the cat is too fat. (*māo tài pàng le.*)

94.6 shòu — thin; slim

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then tall and short.

- *Recall:* say *pàng*, fat — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *gāo*, tall — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *ǎi*, short — **R3**

You'll want to know: shòu

shòu — "thin; slim".

tā hěn gāo, hěn shòu — He's tall and thin.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shòu is inherited from Middle Chinese *srjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed, through an older dictionary, 'lean'.

What you've built

pàng and *shòu*, *gāo* and *ǎi*: two pairs that describe a body, each with a plain 很.

Your turn

- *Say it: shòu*
- *Say it: shòu*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn gāo, hěn shòu* — He's tall and thin.
- *Recall:* say *pàng*, then *shòu*, the pair

Before you move on

What does *shòu* mean? ("Thin; slim".) And its opposite? (***pàng***.)

94.7 我们都是学生

The chapter closes here, with a photograph of a class.

- *Recall:* say *shòu*, thin — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 同学 — *tóngxué*, a classmate — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *gānjìng*, clean — **R2**

The exchange

A: 他们都是你的同学吗

tāmen dōu shì nǐ de tóngxué ma — Are they all your classmates?

B: 对 我们都是学生

duì, wǒmen dōu shì xuésheng — Yes, we're all students.

A: *nǐmen dōu hěn niánqīng* — You're all so young.

B: *wǒmen yíyàng dà* — We're the same age.

A: 那个男人呢

nàge nánrén ne — And that man?

B: *tā shì wǒmen de lǎoshī, tā hěn gāo, hěn shòu* — He's our teacher. He's tall and thin.

A: *nǐ de māo hěn pàng* — Your cat's fat.

B: 也很大

yě hěn dà — And big.

都 gathers everybody before it into one: 他们都, 我们都, 你们都. *yíyàng* matches them up; *gāo*, *shòu* and *pàng* tell them apart.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — describing people

- 我们都是学生 *wǒmen dōu shì xuésheng* — we're all students.
- *wǒmen yíyàng dà* — we're the same age.
- *tā hěn gāo, hěn shòu* — he's tall and thin.
- 他们也都很好 *tāmen yě dōu hěn hǎo* — they're all fine too.

Listen. *Nǐmen dōu shì xuésheng ma?*
Speak. Describe two people you know, then say what they have in common with 都.
Write it: 都 — the left piece first, closed by its 日, then the ear on the right

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我们都是学生 — *wǒmen dōu shì xuésheng* — We're all students.
- *Say it:* 他们也都很好 — *tāmen yě dōu hěn hǎo* — They're all fine too.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我们都是学生

Before you move on

Say you are all students. (我们都是学生.) Say you are the same age. (*wǒmen yíyàng dà.*) Say somebody is young. (*tā hěn niánqīng.*) Which comes first, 也 or 都? (也.)

Chapter 95

Why?

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask why.
>
> *Asking why with* 为什么*, and three everyday answers to it, being busy, the traffic and forgetting, built on one new written character:* 为*.*

95.1 为什么 (wèishénme) — why?

A new chapter, and it opens with the question that wants a reason.

- *Recall:* say 我们都是学生 — *wǒmen dōu shì xuésheng*
- *Recall:* say *tā hěn shòu*, he's thin — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *chídào*, to be late — **R2**

You'll want to know: 为什么

为什么 — *wèishénme* — "why?".

> 你为什么不去 *nǐ wèishénme bú qù* — Why aren't you going?

The next lesson puts the new character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

为什么 (*wèishénme*) is built from 为 'for' and 什么 'what': for what? 为 is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjweH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to help'; 'for' is the sense of acting on somebody's behalf, which the gloss does not spell out. Where 什么 comes from is not settled.

What you've built

为什么 sits after the person and before the verb: 你, 为什么, 不去. 不 before the fall of 去 rises: *bú qù*.

Your turn

- *Say it: wèishénme*
- *Say it: wèishénme*, once more
- *Say it:* 你为什么不去 — *nǐ wèishénme bú qù* — Why aren't you going?
- *Say it: nǐ wèishénme chídào* — Why are you late?
- *Recall:* say *chídào*, then ask why

Before you move on

What does 为什么 ask? ("Why?".) Where does it go? (**After the person, before the verb**.)

95.2 为 — a dot, a long fall, the hook of 男, a dot

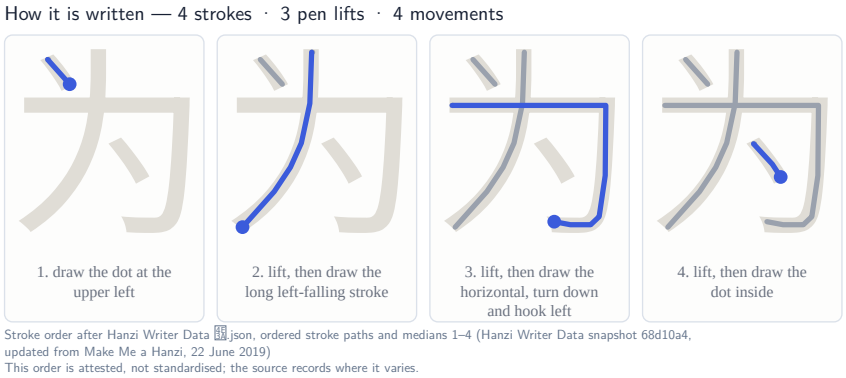
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wèishénme* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

男 点

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nán*, *diǎn*

Script — a dot, a long fall, the hook of 男, a dot



How 为 is written, stroke by stroke

为

Four strokes, and the long one in the middle is a stroke your hand knows from the foot of 男.

A dot at the upper left.

A long left-falling stroke from the top, down to the lower left.

The hooked turn: across, down the right side, hooking to the left, as at the foot of 男.

A dot inside, last.

Four strokes.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 为, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 为? (**Four**.) Where have you made the hooked turn before? (**At the foot of 男**.) Which stroke is last? (**The dot inside**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 为, pinned stroke paths and medians.

95.3 yǒushì — to have something on

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then two words for a full day.

- *Read it:* 为什么, aloud — *wèishénme*
- *Recall:* say *máng*, busy — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say 今天 — *jīntiān*, today

You'll want to know: yǒushì

yǒushì — "to have something on; to be busy".

wǒ jīntiān yǒushì — I've got something on today.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒushì is built from yǒu 'to have', the 有 you write, and shì 'a matter'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun glosses *dzriH* 'to employ; to set up', and 'a matter' is the everyday sense, not the gloss.

What you've built

yǒushì is the polite reason that gives nothing away: something has come up. *máng* says you are busy; *yǒushì* says there is a particular thing.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒushì*
- *Say it: yǒushì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jīntiān yǒushì* — I've got something on today.
- *Recall:* say *máng*, then *yǒushì* again

Before you move on

What does *yǒushì* mean? ("To have something on".) Which written character does it open with? (有.)

95.4 dǔchē — a traffic jam

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words for the road.

- *Recall:* say *yǒushì*, to have something on — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 车 — *chē*, a car
- *Recall:* say *lù*, a road — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: dǔchē

dǔchē — "traffic jam; to be stuck in traffic".

zǎoshang dǔchē — There's a jam in the mornings.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǔchē is built from dǔ 'to block' and chē 'a vehicle', the 车 you write. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *tuX* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun glosses *tuX* as 'a wall', and 'to block' is assumed from that, not quoted.

What you've built

dǔchē is a verb as well as a noun: *zǎoshang dǔchē*, the traffic jams in the morning. No 有 needed.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǔchē*
- *Say it: dǔchē*, once more

- *Say it: zǎoshang dǔchē* — There's a jam in the mornings.
- *Recall:* say *lù*, then *dǔchē* again

Before you move on

What does *dǔchē* mean? ("A traffic jam".) Which written character does it end with? (车.)

95.5 wàng — to forget

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words you might forget.

- *Recall:* say *dǔchē*, a traffic jam — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *zuòyè*, homework — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 马上 — *mǎshàng*, right away

You'll want to know: wàng

wàng — "to forget".

wǒ wàng le — I forgot.

wǒ wàng le wǒ de yàoshi — I forgot my key.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàng is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to leave behind; to forget'.

What you've built

wàng le: with 了 after it, the forgetting has already happened, which is how it is almost always said.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàng*
- *Say it: wàng le*
- *Say it: wǒ wàng le* — I forgot.
- *Say it: wǒ wàng le wǒ de yàoshi* — I forgot my key.
- *Recall:* say *zuòyè*, then say you forgot it

Before you move on

What does *wàng* mean? ("To forget".) Say you forgot. (*wǒ wàng le.*)

95.6 你为什么不去

The chapter closes here, with one person asking why three times.

- *Recall:* say *wàng*, to forget — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *láibují*, to run out of time — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *zuòyè*, homework — **R1**

The exchange

A: *nǐ wèishénme chídào* — Why are you late?

B: *zǎoshang dǔchē* — The traffic this morning.

A: 你明天去吗

nǐ míngtiān qù ma — Are you going tomorrow?

B: 我不去

wǒ bú qù — I'm not going.

A: 为什么

wèishénme — Why?

B: *wǒ yǒushì* — I've got something on.

A: *nǐ de zuòyè ne* — And your homework?

B: *wǒ wàng le* — I forgot.

为什么 can stand alone as a whole question, as A's fifth line does. Each answer here is a reason with nothing in front of it; the next chapter gives the word that introduces one.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — asking why

- 你为什么不去 *nǐ wèishénme bú qù* — why aren't you going?
- 为什么 *wèishénme* — why?
- *wǒ yǒushì* — something has come up.
- *zǎoshang dǔchē* — the traffic this morning.

Listen. *Nǐ wèishénme bù chī fàn?*
Speak. Answer it with any reason you have, then ask somebody why.
Write it: 为 — the dot, the long fall, the hooked turn, the dot inside

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你为什么不去 — *nǐ wèishénme bú qù* — Why aren't you going?
- *Say it: wǒ wàng le* — I forgot.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 为什么

Before you move on

Ask why somebody is not going. (你为什么不去.) Say something has come up. (*wǒ yǒushì.*) Blame the traffic. (*zǎoshang dǔchē.*) Say

you forgot. (*wǒ wàng le.*)

Chapter 96

Because

Modes: **voice** (4) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give one reason with 因为.
> *Giving one reason with* 因为*, and what follows from it with suǒyǐ, built on one new written character:* 因.

96.1 因为 (yīnwèi) — because

A new chapter, and it opens with the answer to the last one's question.

- *Recall:* say 你为什么不去 — *nǐ wèishénme bú qù*
- *Recall:* say *wǒ wàng le*, I forgot — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *dǔchē*, a traffic jam — **R1**

You'll want to know: 因为

因为 — *yīnwèi* — "because".

> 我不去 因为我没有车 *wǒ bú qù, yīnwèi wǒ méiyǒu chē* — I'm not going, because I don't have a car.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

因为 (*yīnwèi*) is built from 因 'to follow from' and 为 'for'. 因 is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to rely on; to follow from'.

What you've built

One reason, in one clause, after what it explains: 我不去, 因为我没有车. It can also come first: 因为我没有车, 我不去.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīnwèi*
- *Say it: yīnwèi*, once more
- *Say it:* 我不去 因为我没有车 — *wǒ bú qù, yīnwèi wǒ méiyǒu chē* — I'm not going, because I don't have a car.
- *Say it:* 因为我没有车 我不去 — *yīnwèi wǒ méiyǒu chē, wǒ bú qù* — Because I don't have a car, I'm not going.
- *Recall:* say *nǐ wèishénme bú qù*, then answer it with 因为

Before you move on

What does 因为 mean? ("Because".) Which question does it answer? (为什么.)

96.2 因 — 大 inside the frame of 国

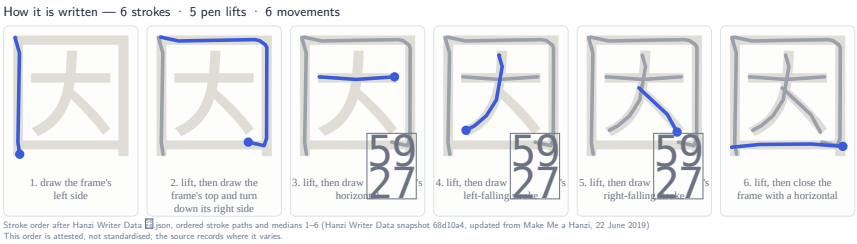
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yīnwèi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

国 大

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *guó, dà*

Script — 大 inside the frame of 国



How 因 is written, stroke by stroke

因

A frame and what it holds, and the frame is closed last, after its contents, as in 国.

The frame, two strokes first: its left side, then its top turning down the right side.

大, three strokes, inside: the bar, the left-falling stroke, the short right-falling stroke.

The bottom bar, last, closing the frame.

2 + 3 + 1 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 因, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 因? (**Six.**) What is inside the frame? (大.) When is the frame closed? (**Last, as in 国.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 因, pinned stroke paths and medians.

96.3 suǒyǐ — so; therefore

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then two words, one of which ends like this one.

- *Read it:* 因为, aloud — *yīnwèi*
- *Recall:* say *lèi*, tired — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *kěyǐ*, may — **R2**

You'll want to know: suǒyǐ

suǒyǐ — "so; therefore".

yīnwèi wǒ hěn lèi, suǒyǐ wǒ bú qù — I'm tired, so I'm not going.

Two dips in a row: spoken, the first rises, *suóyǐ*. It is written *suǒyǐ*. Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suǒyǐ is built from suǒ 'a place; that which' and yǐ 'to use', the yǐ of *kěyǐ*. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjoX* and *yiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *srjoX* glossed 'a place'. The regular change from *srjoX* would give shǔ, not suǒ, so why it is said suǒ is not settled.

What you've built

因为 gives the reason, *suǒyǐ* what follows from it. Mandarin often says both: *yīnwèi …, suǒyǐ …*. Either half can also stand alone.

Your turn

- *Say it: suǒyǐ* — and hear it as *suóyǐ*
- *Say it: yīnwèi wǒ hěn lèi, suǒyǐ wǒ bú qù* — I'm tired, so I'm not going.
- *Recall:* say *kěyǐ*, then *suǒyǐ*, and hear the same yǐ

Before you move on

What does *suǒyǐ* mean? ("So; therefore".) Which half gives the reason, 因为 or *suǒyǐ*? (因为.)

96.4 shūfu — comfortable; well

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words about health.

- *Recall:* say *suǒyǐ*, so — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *shēntǐ*, health — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *bìng*, to fall ill — **R2**

You'll want to know: shūfu

shūfu — "comfortable; well".

wǒ bù shūfu — I'm not feeling well.

zhège yǐzi hěn shūfu — This chair is comfortable.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shūfu is built from shū 'to stretch; to ease' and fu, the fu of *yīfu*. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *syo* and *bjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *syo* glossed 'slow; to stretch out'.

What you've built

wǒ bù shūfu is the gentle way to say you are unwell, and a reason nobody argues with: *yīnwèi wǒ bù shūfu*.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūfu*
- *Say it: shūfu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù shūfu* — I'm not feeling well.
- *Say it: zhège yǐzi hěn shūfu* — This chair is comfortable.
- *Recall:* say *bìng*, then *shūfu* again

Before you move on

What does *shūfu* mean? ("Comfortable; well".) Say you are not feeling well. (*wǒ bù shūfu.*)

96.5 为什么 — 因为

The chapter closes here, with every why answered.

- *Recall:* say *shūfu*, comfortable — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *è*, hungry — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say 上课 — *shàngkè*, to go to class — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你为什么不吃饭

nǐ wèishénme bù chī fàn — Why aren't you eating?

B: *yīnwèi wǒ bú è* — Because I'm not hungry.

A: 你为什么不去上课

nǐ wèishénme bú qù shàngkè — Why aren't you going to class?

B: *yīnwèi wǒ bù shūfu, suǒyǐ wǒ bú qù* — I'm not feeling well, so I'm not going.

A: 你明天能来吗

nǐ míngtiān néng lái ma — Can you come tomorrow?

B: 能

néng — I can.

为什么 asks; 因为 answers, with one reason in one clause; *suǒyǐ* carries the reason on to what happens.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — a question and its reason

- 你为什么不去 *nǐ wèishénme bú qù* — why aren't you going?
- 因为我没有车 *yīnwèi wǒ méiyǒu chē* — because I don't have a car.
- *yīnwèi wǒ hěn lèi, suǒyǐ wǒ bú qù* — I'm tired, so I'm not going.

Listen. *Nǐ wèishénme xuéxí Hànyǔ?*
Speak. Answer it with 因为 and one reason of your own.
Write it: 因 — the frame's two sides, 大 inside, then the bar that closes it

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你为什么不去 — *nǐ wèishénme bú qù* — Why aren't you going?
- *Say it:* 因为我没有车 — *yīnwèi wǒ méiyǒu chē* — Because I don't have a car.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 因为

Before you move on

Give a reason with no car in it. (因为我没有车.) Say you are not well, so you are not going. (*yīnwèi wǒ bù shūfu, suǒyǐ wǒ bú qù.*) Which question does 因为 answer? (为什么.)

Chapter 97

My Day in Characters

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read a short day in characters and write one line of my own.
>
> *Complete ZH-W97-my-own-line: one line of your own Chinese about where you are, what you want and for how long, chosen rather than copied, with every word you have not written in pinyin.*

97.1 小时 (xiǎoshí) — hour

A new chapter, and it opens with a word for measuring a day.

- *Recall:* say 为什么, then answer it with 因为 — *wèishénme*, *yīnwèi*
- *Recall:* say *wǒ bù shūfu*, I'm not feeling well — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *shíhou*, a time; a moment — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *xiǎoshíhou*, in childhood — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 小时

小时 — *xiǎoshí* — "hour".

一个小时 *yí ge xiǎoshí* — an hour

The next lesson puts the second character in your hand. It is the shí of *shíhou* and *xiǎoshíhou*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小时 (*xiǎoshí*) is built from 小 'small' and 时 'time'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *dzyi* glossed 'a season; a time'.

What you've built

一 before 个 rises: *yí ge xiǎoshí*, an hour. Before the other tones it falls: *yì tiān*, a day; *yì nián*, a year. Time words count with 一 as often as anything does.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoshí*
- *Say it: xiǎoshí*, once more
- *Say it:* 一个小时 — *yí ge xiǎoshí* — an hour
- *Say it:* 一天 — *yì tiān* — a day
- *Say it:* 一年 — *yì nián* — a year
- *Recall:* say *shíhou*, then *xiǎoshí*, and hear the same shí

Before you move on

What does 小时 mean? ("Hour".) Say an hour, and listen to 一. (*yí ge xiǎoshí*: 一 rises before 个.)

97.2 时 — 日, then the right half of 对

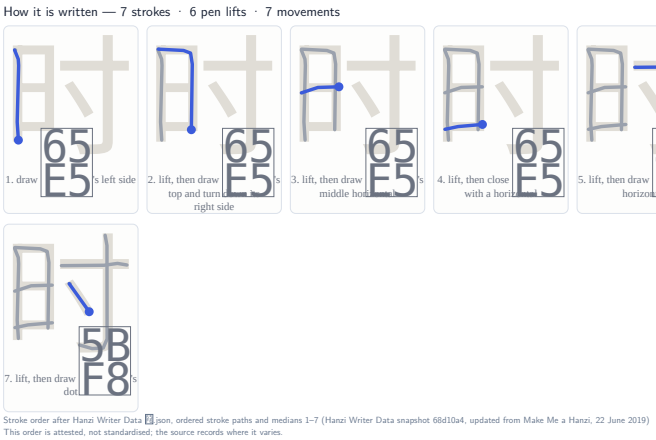
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiǎoshí* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 对

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *duì*

Script — 日, then the right half of 对



How 时 *is written, stroke by stroke*

时

Two pieces you own, side by side.

日**, four strokes**, narrow, on the left: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, the bottom bar.

The right half of 对**, three strokes**: the bar, the vertical that hooks to the left at its foot, then the dot.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 时, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 时? (**Seven**.) Which character is on the left? (日.) Where have you written the right half? (**At the end of** 对.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 时, pinned stroke paths and medians.

97.3 měitiān — every day

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character, then a day with 一 in front of it.

- *Read it:* 两个小时, aloud — *liǎng ge xiǎoshí*, two hours
- *Recall:* say 一天 — *yì tiān*, a day, with 一 falling

You'll want to know: měitiān

měitiān — "every day".

wǒ měitiān hē chá — I drink tea every day.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

měitiān is built from měi 'each' and tiān 'day', the 天 you write. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *mwojX* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun glosses *mwojX* 'frequently', and 'each' is assumed from that, not quoted.

What you've built

A time word goes early, after the person and before the verb: 我, *měitiān*, *hē chá*. *yì tiān* is one day; *měitiān* is every day.

Your turn

- *Say it: měitiān*
- *Say it: měitiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān hē chá* — I drink tea every day.
- *Recall:* say *yì tiān*, then *měitiān*

Before you move on

What does *měitiān* mean? ("Every day".) Where does it go? (**After the person, before the verb**.)

97.4 yǐhòu — after; afterwards

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words for school and after.

- *Recall:* say *měitiān*, every day — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 下课 — *xiàkè*, to finish class
- *Recall:* say *hòu*, after; behind — **R2**

You'll want to know: yǐhòu

yǐhòu — "after; afterwards".

xiàkè yǐhòu, wǒ qù chī fàn — After class I go and eat.

yí ge xiǎoshí yǐhòu — an hour later

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǐhòu is built from yǐ, the yǐ of *kěyǐ*, and hòu 'after', the *hòu* you know. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *yiX* and *huwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *huwX* glossed 'after, in order'.

What you've built

yǐhòu comes after the thing it follows: *xiàkè yǐhòu*, after class; *yí ge xiǎoshí yǐhòu*, an hour later.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐhòu*
- *Say it: yǐhòu*, once more
- *Say it: xiàkè yǐhòu, wǒ qù chī fàn* — After class I go and eat.
- *Say it: yí ge xiǎoshí yǐhòu* — an hour later
- *Recall:* say *hòu*, then *yǐhòu*

Before you move on

What does *yǐhòu* mean? ("After; afterwards".) Where does it go? (**After the thing it follows: *xiàkè yǐhòu*.**)

97.5 (reading) — a Sunday at home

Fifty-seven characters in a row, and every one is a character you write.

- *Recall:* say *xiàkè yǐhòu*, after class — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *jiàoshì*, a classroom — **R3**, durable

  上课 下课

Read it: both aloud, with nothing said first — *shàngkè*, *xiàkè*

Read this

今天是星期天 我和妈妈都在家 妈妈做饭 我看书 我想喝水
也想吃饭 妈妈说 饭太多了 我说 太好了 下午两点 我们去买
书 因为我很喜欢看书

Read it: the passage through once without stopping; do not translate as you go
Read it: the passage again, and this time notice where the day turns: the line with the time in it

Read this

jīntiān shì xīngqītiān wǒ hé māma dōu zài jiā māma zuò
fàn wǒ kàn shū wǒ xiǎng hē shuǐ yě xiǎng chī fàn māma
shuō fàn tài duō le wǒ shuō tài hǎo le xiàwǔ liǎng diǎn
wǒmen qù mǎi shū yīnwèi wǒ hěn xǐhuan kàn shū

One line per clause, and no punctuation, as this book prints Chinese: the line breaks carry the pauses. 饭太多了 is 太 … 了 as a complaint, too much rice; 太好了 a line later is the same frame as delight.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the passage aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Who is at home? (我和妈妈: the writer and Mum.) Why do they go to buy books? (因为我很喜欢看书.) Which line is a complaint, and which a delight? (饭太多了**, then** 太好了.)

97.6 My own line — the first Chinese with no model

Everything you have written so far had something to reach for: a model to trace, a word somebody said, a sentence printed above the space.

This does not. You choose the words, from a supply that is closed: what this book has given you.

- *Recall:* say 两个小时 — *liǎng ge xiǎoshí*, two hours

Writing — controlled composition

Write **one line** of your own about your day. Three parts, in your own words: where you are, with 在; what you want, with 想要 or 要; and for how long, with 一个小时 or 两个小时. If you want a second thing, 也 brings it in, in front of its verb.

Some words you will want have characters you have not written yet: *měitiān*, every day; *yǐhòu*, after. Write those in pinyin, inside the line, with their tone marks. This task allows that, and it allows nothing else: a character you can read but have not learned to write is not one you produce, so it goes in pinyin too.

Three checks belong to the hand. Write each character in the stroke order you learned: 时 is 日 first, narrow, then the hooked vertical and the dot. Give every character **the same size of square**, two-stroke 了 as much as ten-stroke 都. And leave a space between clauses: no Chinese comma or full stop, as this book prints them.

Write the line. Then read it back, and check that every pinyin word has its tone marks before you check anything else.

Before you move on

Which words did you write in pinyin? (**Any whose characters you have not written: *měitiān*, *yǐhòu*.**)
Which piece of 时 comes first? (日, narrow, on the left.)
And what did you choose here that the earlier lessons chose for you? (**The words.**)

Chapter 98

With a Clock

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can fill a short form and write a short message against a clock.
>
> *Complete ZH-R98-review-final-98: one dialogue across the A1 core, where, what there is, how many, giving, can, want, too, all, why and because, after a five-field form and a short message under this book's own three-minute clock.*

98.1 The same writing, with a clock

You wrote your own line with as long as you liked.

A task you can only do untimed is not yet a task you can do.

A friend has sent you a message:

> 你在哪儿 你想要什么

Read it: the message aloud — *nǐ zài nǎr, nǐ xiǎngyào shénme*

Writing — timed production

What is official, and what is not. This book's A1 target is project-defined: aligned to HSK 3.0 Level 1, a match this book makes, not one the HSK publishes. Because the current trial pairs no speaking paper with Level 1, the complete A1 target adds independently scored speaking and productive writing, and at A1 the candidate writes a small form and a short

message. No HSK timing is given here; the clock below is **this book's own**, not a published one.

Set a **three-minute timer**. Fill five fields first. Every label is written in characters you write:

- 名字
- 多大
- 家在哪儿
- 喜欢什么
- 想要什么

Then, before the timer rings, write back to your friend: **20 to 30 characters**, saying where you are, what you want, and one reason with 因为. This task allows pinyin for a word whose characters you have not written; it goes inside the message, and only characters count toward the 20 to 30. Do not look a character up.

Speed is where stroke order shows. A character written in the order you learned keeps its shape when you hurry. When the timer rings, **stop**, even mid-character.

Before you move on

Spend **at most one minute** checking, and do not rewrite the timed answer. Did your reason start with 因为? Did every field get an answer?
Now the rule worth carrying out of this lesson. In this book, writing is its own paper, scored out of 100, with 60 to pass, and it is not averaged against reading, listening or speaking. A high reading score cannot make up for writing that is not there.

98.2 The A1 core — once more

The last lesson of the A1 core: one conversation that uses every chapter of it.

- *Recall:* say 你在哪儿, and answer it — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *yí ge xiǎoshí yǐhòu*, an hour later — **R1**

Your turn

A: 你在哪儿

nǐ zài nǎr — Where are you?

B: 我在家

wǒ zài jiā — At home.

A: *nǐ jiā yǒu méiyǒu bīngxiāng* — Have you got a fridge at home?

B: 有

yǒu — Yes.

A: 给我一点儿水

gěi wǒ yìdiǎnr shuǐ — Give me a little water, then.

B: *gěi nǐ, liǎng bēi* — Here you are: two glasses.

A: 太好了

tài hǎo le — Great!

B: *nǐ huì yóuyǒng ma* — Can you swim?

A: 会 我也想去

huì, wǒ yě xiǎng qù — I can, and I'd like to come too.

B: 我们都去吗

wǒmen dōu qù ma — Are we all going?

A: 我妈妈不去

wǒ māma bú qù — My mum isn't going.

B: 为什么

wèishénme — Why?

A: *yīnwèi tā bù shūfu* — Because she isn't feeling well.

B: *wǒ měitiān yóuyǒng liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — I swim for two hours every day.

A: *yí ge xiǎoshí yǐhòu qù* — Let's go in an hour, then.

- *Read it:* the lines printed in characters aloud, then the rest
- *Say it:* the whole dialogue, both parts
- *Say it:* B's lines again, with your own answers

Before you move on

Where? (哪儿.) Not have? (没有.) Two of something? (两.) Give? (给.) Can? (会, 能, *kěyǐ*.) Want? (想要.) Too? (也.) Great? (太好了.) All? (都.) Why? (为什么.) Because? (因为.) An hour? (一个小时.)

Chapter 99

Getting Washed

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say wash, brush my teeth, wash my face, have a shower and comb my hair.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 99: I can say wash, brush my teeth, wash my face, have a shower and comb my hair.*

99.1 洗 (xǐ) — to wash

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for every day, then the Mandarin for after.

You'll want to know: 洗

洗 — *xǐ* — "to wash".

> 我去洗手 *wǒ qù xǐ shǒu* — I'm going to wash my hands.

The new character, in pieces: 洗 — the water piece of 汉 on the left; on the right a six-stroke piece read xiān, the first syllable of xiānsheng. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

洗 (*xǐ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *sejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to wash and bathe'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐ*
- *Say it: xǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù xǐ shǒu* — I'm going to wash my hands.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for every day, then the Mandarin for after, then say *xǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 洗 mean? ("To wash".) Say it once more.

99.2 洗 — the water piece, then xiān

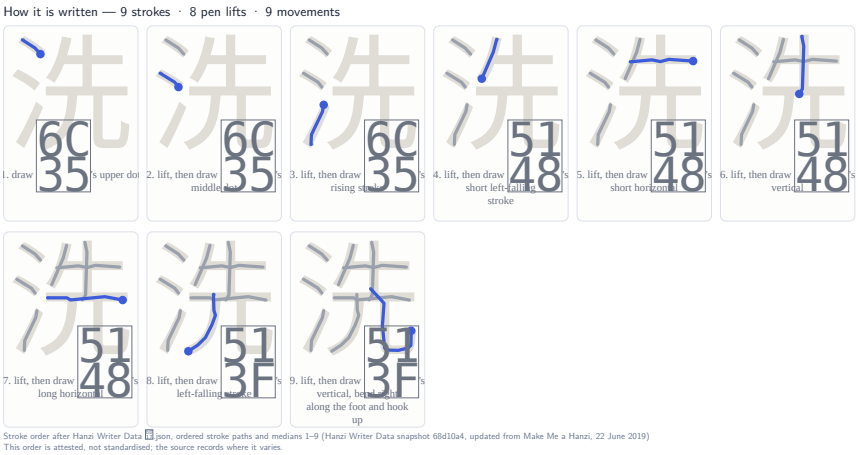
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  汉 没 儿

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hàn*, *méi*, *ér*

Script — the water piece, then xiān



How 洗 *is written, stroke by stroke*

洗

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The water piece, three strokes, as in 汉 and 没: a dot, a second dot under it, then a stroke that rises from the bottom left.

The right piece, xiān, six strokes: a short left-falling stroke, a horizontal, a vertical down through it, a long horizontal; then a left-falling stroke, and a vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up, as at the foot of 儿.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 洗, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 洗? (**Two** — the water piece, then xiān.)
Which characters you know have the same water piece? (汉 and 没.)
What does the last stroke look like? (**The right stroke of** 儿.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 洗, pinned stroke paths and medians.

99.3 shuāyá — to brush one's teeth

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for after, then the Mandarin for to wash.

You'll want to know: shuāyá

shuāyá — "to brush one's teeth".

wǒ měitiān zǎoshang shuāyá — I brush my teeth every morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuāyá is built from shuā 'to brush' and yá 'tooth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srwaet* and *ngae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to brush and wipe' and 'teeth'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuāyá*
- *Say it: shuāyá*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān zǎoshang shuāyá* — I brush my teeth every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for after, then the Mandarin for to wash, then say *shuāyá* again

Before you move on

What does shuāyá mean? ("To brush one's teeth".) Say it once more.

99.4 xǐliǎn — to wash one's face

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wash, then the Mandarin for to brush one's teeth.

You'll want to know: xǐliǎn

xǐliǎn — "to wash one's face".

nǐ xǐliǎn le ma — Have you washed your face?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones in a row: xǐ is said with a rising tone before liǎn, though both are written with the third tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐliǎn is built from 洗 'to wash' and liǎn 'face'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *sejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second, *leamX*, as the name of a kind of stew, so how it came to mean face is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐliǎn*
- *Say it: xǐliǎn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐliǎn le ma* — Have you washed your face?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wash, then the Mandarin for to brush one's teeth, then say *xǐliǎn* again

Before you move on

What does xǐliǎn mean? ("To wash one's face".) Say it once more.

99.5 xǐzǎo — to have a shower; to have a bath

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to brush one's teeth, then the Mandarin for to wash one's face.

You'll want to know: xǐzǎo

xǐzǎo — "to have a shower; to have a bath".

wǒ wǎnshang xǐzǎo — I have a shower in the evening.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones again: xǐ rises before zǎo, and is still written xǐ.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐzǎo is built from 洗 and zǎo, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejX* and *tsawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to wash and bathe' and the second with the first: to wash.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐzǎo*
- *Say it: xǐzǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wǎnshang xǐzǎo* — I have a shower in the evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to brush one's teeth, then the Mandarin for to wash one's face, then say *xǐzǎo* again

Before you move on

What does xǐzǎo mean? ("To have a shower; to have a bath".) Say it once more.

99.6 shūtóu — to comb one's hair

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wash one's face, then the Mandarin for to have a shower.

You'll want to know: shūtóu

shūtóu — "to comb one's hair".

wǒ zǎoshang shūtóu — I comb my hair in the morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shūtóu is built from shū 'to comb' and tóu 'head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjo* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a comb, for putting the hair in order.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūtóu*
- *Say it: shūtóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zǎoshang shūtóu* — I comb my hair in the morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wash one's face, then the Mandarin for to have a shower, then say *shūtóu* again

Before you move on

What does shūtóu mean? ("To comb one's hair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 100

Around Town

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the bank, the supermarket, the park, the library and the post office.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 100: I can name the bank, the supermarket, the park, the library and the post office.*

100.1 yínháng — bank

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a shower, then the Mandarin for to comb one's hair.

You'll want to know: yínháng

yínháng — "bank".

> *yínháng zài nǎr* — Where's the bank?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yínháng is built from yín 'silver' and háng 'a row', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngin* and *hang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Háng is usually explained as a row of shops and then a trade; the step is not given there, so how the pair came to mean a bank is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: yínháng*
- *Say it: yínháng*, once more
- *Say it: yínháng zài nǎr* — Where's the bank?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a shower, then the Mandarin for to comb one's hair, then say *yínháng* again

Before you move on

What does yínháng mean? ("Bank".) Say it once more.

100.2 chāoshì — supermarket

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to comb one's hair, then the Mandarin for bank.

You'll want to know: chāoshì

chāoshì — "supermarket".

wǒ qù chāoshì mǎi shuǐguǒ — I'm off to the supermarket for some fruit.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chāoshì is built from chāo and shì 'market', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trhjew* and *dzyiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to leap'; 'super' is its sense in this modern word.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāoshì*
- *Say it: chāoshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù chāoshì mǎi shuǐguǒ* — I'm off to the supermarket for some fruit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to comb one's hair, then the Mandarin for bank, then say *chāoshì* again

Before you move on

What does chāoshì mean? ("Supermarket".) Say it once more.

100.3 gōngyuán — park

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bank, then the Mandarin for supermarket.

You'll want to know: gōngyuán

gōngyuán — "park".

wǒmen qù gōngyuán wán — We're going to the park to play.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngyuán is built from gōng 'public' and yuán 'garden', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *hjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a garden for everyone.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngyuán*
- *Say it: gōngyuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù gōngyuán wán* — We're going to the park to play.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bank, then the Mandarin for supermarket, then say *gōngyuán* again

Before you move on

What does gōngyuán mean? ("Park".) Say it once more.

100.4 túshūguǎn — library

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for supermarket, then the Mandarin for park.

You'll want to know: túshūguǎn

túshūguǎn — "library".

wǒ qù túshūguǎn kàn shū — I'm going to the library to read.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

túshūguǎn is built from tú 'picture', 书 'book' and guǎn 'hall', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *du*, *syo* and *kwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to plan' and the last as a lodging house for guests.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: túshūguǎn*
- *Say it: túshūguǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù túshūguǎn kàn shū* — I'm going to the library to read.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for supermarket, then the Mandarin for park, then say *túshūguǎn* again

Before you move on

What does túshūguǎn mean? ("Library".) Say it once more.

100.5 yóujú — post office

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for park, then the Mandarin for library.

You'll want to know: yóujú

yóujú — "post office".

yóujú zài yínháng pángbiān — The post office is next to the bank.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóujú is built from yóu 'post' and jú 'office', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuw* and *gjowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a lodge on the border and the second as a government office.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóujú*
- *Say it: yóujú*, once more
- *Say it: yóujú zài yínháng pángbiān* — The post office is next to the bank.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for park, then the Mandarin for library, then say *yóujú* again

Before you move on

What does yóujú mean? ("Post office".) Say it once more.

Chapter 101

In the Kitchen

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the kitchen, cabbage, chopsticks, plates and a knife.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 101: I can name the kitchen, cabbage, chopsticks, plates and a knife.*

101.1 chúfáng — kitchen

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for library, then the Mandarin for post office.

You'll want to know: chúfáng

chúfáng — "kitchen".

> *māma zài chúfáng* — Mum's in the kitchen.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chúfáng is built from chú and fáng 'room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drju* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as the house where food is cooked.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chúfáng*
- *Say it: chúfáng*, once more
- *Say it: māma zài chúfáng* — Mum's in the kitchen.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for library, then the Mandarin for post office, then say *chúfáng* again

Before you move on

What does chúfáng mean? ("Kitchen".) Say it once more.

101.2 白菜 (báicài) — Chinese cabbage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for post office, then the Mandarin for kitchen.

You'll want to know: 白菜

白菜 — *báicài* — "Chinese cabbage".

我去洗白菜 *wǒ qù xǐ báicài* — I'll go and wash the cabbage.

The new character, in pieces: 菜 — the grass piece on top, three strokes; under it a hand reaching down, four strokes; and at the foot the tree piece of 机, standing alone. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

白菜 (*báicài*) is built from 白 'white' and 菜 'vegetable', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *baek* and *tshojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary says every plant that can be eaten is called *tshojH*; the white one is probably named for its pale stalks.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: báicài*
- *Say it: báicài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù xǐ báicài* — I'll go and wash the cabbage.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for post office, then the Mandarin for kitchen, then say *báicài* again

Before you move on

What does 白菜 mean? ("Chinese cabbage".) Say it once more.

101.3 菜 — the grass piece, a hand, the tree piece

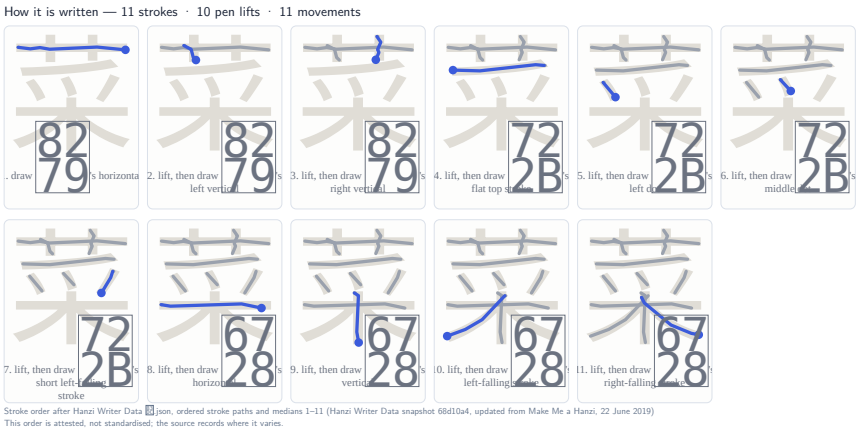
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *báicài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  机 白

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jī*, *bái*

Script — the grass piece, a hand, the tree piece



How 菜 is written, stroke by stroke

菜

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The grass piece, three strokes: a horizontal across the top, then two short verticals through it, left before right.

The hand, four strokes: a left-falling stroke across, two dots under it, left then middle, and a short left-falling stroke on the right.

The tree piece, four strokes, full width at the foot: a horizontal, a vertical down through it, a left-falling stroke and a long right-falling one.

3 + 4 + 4 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 菜, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 菜? (**Three** — the grass piece, a hand, the tree piece.) Which character you know has the tree piece? (机, on its left.) How does 菜 end? (**With a long right-falling stroke**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 菜, pinned stroke paths and medians.

101.4 kuàizi — chopsticks

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for kitchen, then the Mandarin for cabbage.

You'll want to know: kuàizi

kuàizi — "chopsticks".

wǒ de kuàizi ne — Where are my chopsticks?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kuàizi is built from kuài and the noun ending zi. The ending is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuàizi*
- *Say it: kuàizi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de kuàizi ne* — Where are my chopsticks?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for kitchen, then the Mandarin for cabbage, then say *kuàizi* again

Before you move on

What does kuàizi mean? ("Chopsticks".) Say it once more.

101.5 pánzi — plate; dish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cabbage, then the Mandarin for chopsticks.

You'll want to know: pánzi

pánzi — "plate; dish".

zhège pánzi hěn gānjìng — This plate is nice and clean.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pánzi is built from pán and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ban* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as the name of a vessel.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: pánzi*
- *Say it: pánzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège pánzi hěn gānjìng* — This plate is nice and clean.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cabbage, then the Mandarin for chopsticks, then say *pánzi* again

Before you move on

What does pánzi mean? ("Plate; dish".) Say it once more.

101.6 dāo — knife

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for chopsticks, then the Mandarin for plate.

You'll want to know: dāo

dāo — "knife".

dāo zài zhuōzi shàngbian — The knife is on the table.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dāo is inherited from Middle Chinese *taw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary glosses as a weapon, a blade for cutting things down. In the kitchen it is the knife.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāo*
- *Say it: dāo*, once more
- *Say it: dāo zài zhuōzi shàngbian* — The knife is on the table.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for chopsticks, then the Mandarin for plate, then say *dāo* again

Before you move on

What does dāo mean? ("Knife".) Say it once more.

Chapter 102

Something to Drink

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for a drink: juice, cola or beer, and a biscuit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 102: I can ask for a drink: juice, cola or beer, and a biscuit.*

102.1 yǐnliào — drink; soft drink

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for plate, then the Mandarin for knife.

You'll want to know: yǐnliào

yǐnliào — "drink; soft drink".

> *nǐ xiǎng hē shénme yǐnliào* — What would you like to drink?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǐnliào is built from yǐn 'to drink' and liào, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'imX* and *lew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'to measure' and lists it with a departing tone too, *lewH*, the one liào continues; how the pair came to mean a drink is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐnliào*
- *Say it: yǐnliào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xiǎng hē shénme yǐnliào* — What would you like to drink?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for plate, then the Mandarin for knife, then say *yǐnliào* again

Before you move on

What does yǐnliào mean? ("Drink; soft drink".) Say it once more.

102.2 guǒzhī — fruit juice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for knife, then the Mandarin for soft drink.

You'll want to know: guǒzhī

guǒzhī — "fruit juice".

wǒ yào yì bēi guǒzhī — A glass of juice for me, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǒzhī is built from guǒ 'fruit' and zhī 'juice', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaX* and *tsyip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the fruit of a tree' and 'liquid'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǒzhī*
- *Say it: guǒzhī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào yì bēi guǒzhī* — A glass of juice for me, please.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for knife, then the Mandarin for soft drink, then say *guǒzhī* again

Before you move on

What does guǒzhī mean? (“Fruit juice”.) Say it once more.

102.3 kělè — cola

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for soft drink, then the Mandarin for juice.

You’ll want to know: kělè

kělè — “cola”.

tāmen dōu hē kělè — They all drink cola.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kělè is borrowed from the name of a cola drink, usually traced to English *cola*; its two syllables are written with the characters for kě ’may’ and lè ’joy’, chosen for their sound.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: kělè*
- *Say it: kělè*, once more

- *Say it: tāmen dōu hē kělè* — They all drink cola.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for soft drink, then the Mandarin for juice, then say *kělè* again

Before you move on

What does kělè mean? ("Cola".) Say it once more.

102.4 píjiǔ — beer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for juice, then the Mandarin for cola.

You'll want to know: píjiǔ

píjiǔ — "beer".

wǒ bù hē píjiǔ — I don't drink beer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píjiǔ is built from pí and jiǔ 'alcoholic drink'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the first is borrowed for its sound from a European word for beer, usually traced to English *beer*.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: píjiǔ*
- *Say it: píjiǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù hē píjiǔ* — I don't drink beer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for juice, then the Mandarin for cola, then say *píjiǔ* again

Before you move on

What does píjiǔ mean? (“Beer”.) Say it once more.

102.5 bǐnggān — biscuit; cracker

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cola, then the Mandarin for beer.

You’ll want to know: bǐnggān

bǐnggān — “biscuit; cracker”.

wǒ xiǎngyào yí kuài bǐnggān — I’d like a biscuit.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǐnggān is built from bǐng, a flat cake, and gān ’dry’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjiengX* and *kan* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription); gān is the gān of gānjìng ’clean’.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǐnggān*
- *Say it: bǐnggān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎngyào yí kuài bǐnggān* — I’d like a biscuit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cola, then the Mandarin for beer, then say *bǐnggān* again

Before you move on

What does bǐnggān mean? (“Biscuit; cracker”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 103

Using Things

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say use, take, throw away and repair, and say something is broken.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 103: I can say use, take, throw away and repair, and say something is broken.*

103.1 用 (yòng) — to use

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for beer, then the Mandarin for biscuit.

You'll want to know: 用

用 — *yòng* — "to use".

我用水洗菜 *wǒ yòng shuǐ xǐ cài* — I wash the vegetables in water.

The new character, in pieces: 用 — the frame of the moon piece in 明, open at the foot, with two bars inside and a vertical down the middle. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

用 (*yòng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *yowngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to employ' and 'by means of'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: yòng*
- *Say it: yòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yòng shuǐ xǐ cài* — I wash the vegetables in water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for beer, then the Mandarin for biscuit, then say *yòng* again

Before you move on

What does 用 mean? ("To use".) Say it once more.

103.2 用 — the moon frame, two bars, a vertical

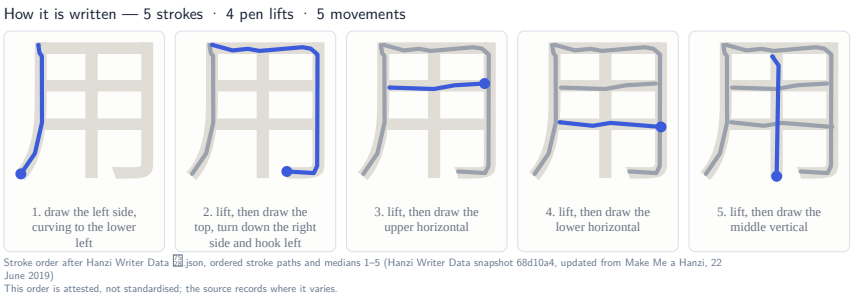
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yòng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

明 能

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *míng*, *néng*

Script — the moon frame, two bars, a vertical



How 用 is written, stroke by stroke

用

The frame, two strokes, as on the right of 明: a left-falling stroke down the left side, then a stroke across the top that turns down the right side and hooks.

Two horizontals inside, one above the other.

A vertical down the middle, from the top through both bars to the foot.

2 + 2 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 用, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 用? (**Five**.) Which character you know has the same frame? (明, on its right.) Which stroke comes last? (**The vertical down the middle**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 用, pinned stroke paths and medians.

103.3 ná — to take; to hold

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for biscuit, then the Mandarin for to use.

You'll want to know: ná

ná — "to take; to hold".

nǐ ná wǒ de yàoshi le ma — Did you take my keys?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ná is probably inherited from Middle Chinese *nrae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary lists under an older form of the character, glossed 'to pull'. That the two are one word is likely;

how 'to pull' became 'to take' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: ná*
- *Say it: ná*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ ná wǒ de yàoshi le ma* — Did you take my keys?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for biscuit, then the Mandarin for to use, then say *ná* again

Before you move on

What does ná mean? ("To take; to hold".) Say it once more.

103.4 rēng — to throw; to throw away

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to use, then the Mandarin for to take hold of.

You'll want to know: rēng

rēng — "to throw; to throw away".

bú yào rēng wǒ de shū — Don't throw my books away.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rēng is inherited from Middle Chinese *nying* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to pull'. The regular change from *nying* gives réng, with a rising tone, not the level rēng of today, and throwing is not given there; how the word came to its sound and sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: rēng*
- *Say it: rēng*, once more
- *Say it: bú yào rēng wǒ de shū* — Don't throw my books away.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to use, then the Mandarin for to take hold of, then say *rēng* again

Before you move on

What does rēng mean? ("To throw; to throw away".) Say it once more.

103.5 xiū — to repair; to fix

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take hold of, then the Mandarin for to throw away.

You'll want to know: xiū

xiū — "to repair; to fix".

tā huì xiū diànnǎo — He knows how to fix computers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiū is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to put in order' and 'to adorn'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiū*
- *Say it: xiū*, once more
- *Say it: tā huì xiū diànnǎo* — He knows how to fix computers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take hold of, then the Mandarin for to throw away, then say *xiū* again

Before you move on

What does xiū mean? ("To repair; to fix".) Say it once more.

103.6 huài — broken; bad

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to throw away, then the Mandarin for to repair.

You'll want to know: huài

huài — "broken; bad".

wǒ de shǒujī huài le — My phone's broken.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huài is inherited from Middle Chinese *hweajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to break of itself'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: huài*
- *Say it: huài*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ de shǒujī huài le* — My phone's broken.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to throw away, then the Mandarin for to repair, then say *huài* again

Before you move on

What does huài mean? ("Broken; bad".) Say it once more.

Chapter 104

On the Desk

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a notebook, a pen, a pencil, paper and a dictionary.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 104: I can name a notebook, a pen, a pencil, paper and a dictionary.*

104.1 本子 (běnzi) — notebook

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to repair, then the Mandarin for broken.

You'll want to know: 本子

本子 — *běnzi* — "notebook".

> 我能用你的本子吗 *wǒ néng yòng nǐ de běnzi ma* — Could I use your notebook?

The new character, in pieces: 本 — the tree piece of 机, standing alone, with a short bar across its foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

本子 (*běnzi*) is built from 本 and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwonX* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'root' and explains its

shape as a tree with a mark at its foot; how it came to mean a book is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: běnzi*
- *Say it: běnzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ néng yòng nǐ de běnzi ma* — Could I use your notebook?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to repair, then the Mandarin for broken, then say *běnzi* again

Before you move on

What does 本子 mean? ("Notebook".) Say it once more.

104.2 本 — the tree piece, and a bar at its foot

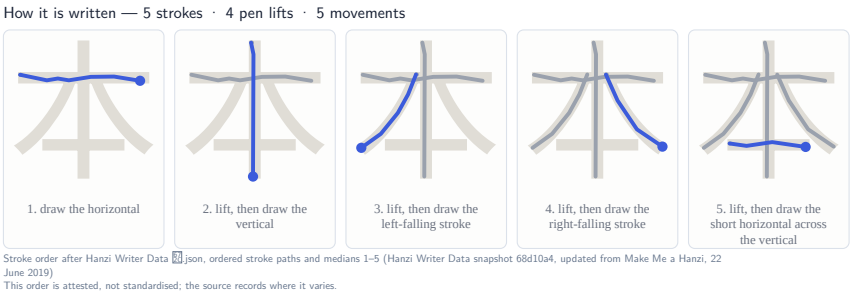
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *běnzi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  机 子

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jī*, *zǐ*

Script — the tree piece, and a bar at its foot



How 本 *is written, stroke by stroke*

本

The tree piece, four strokes, as on the left of 机 but full width: a horizontal, a vertical down through it, a left-falling stroke and a long right-falling one.

A short horizontal across the vertical, low down: the mark at the root.

4 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 本, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 本? (**Five.**) Where is the short bar? (**Low down, across the vertical.**) Which character you know has the same tree piece? (机.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 本, pinned stroke paths and medians.

104.3 bǐ — pen

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for broken, then the Mandarin for notebook.

You'll want to know: bǐ

bǐ — "pen".

nǐ yǒu bǐ ma — Have you got a pen?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǐ is inherited from Middle Chinese *pit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), the writing brush; the dictionary repeats a story that a general of the Qin dynasty made the first one.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǐ*
- *Say it: bǐ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu bǐ ma* — Have you got a pen?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for broken, then the Mandarin for notebook, then say *bǐ* again

Before you move on

What does bǐ mean? ("Pen".) Say it once more.

104.4 qiānbǐ — pencil

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for notebook, then the Mandarin for pen.

You'll want to know: qiānbǐ

qiānbǐ — "pencil".

wǒ yòng qiānbǐ xiě zì — I write with a pencil.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiānbǐ is built from qiān 'lead' and bǐ 'pen', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ywen* and *pit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a grey-blue metal. The regular change from *ywen* gives yuán, not qiān; how the word came to its sound is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiānbǐ*
- *Say it: qiānbǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yòng qiānbǐ xiě zì* — I write with a pencil.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for notebook, then the Mandarin for pen, then say *qiānbǐ* again

Before you move on

What does qiānbǐ mean? ("Pencil".) Say it once more.

104.5 zhǐ — paper

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pen, then the Mandarin for pencil.

You'll want to know: zhǐ

zhǐ — "paper".

qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng zhǐ — Could I have a sheet of paper, please?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǐ is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where the dictionary says paper is as smooth as a whetstone, and that in the Later Han it was made from old fishing nets and tree bark.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǐ*
- *Say it: zhǐ*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng zhǐ* — Could I have a sheet of paper, please?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pen, then the Mandarin for pencil, then say *zhǐ* again

Before you move on

What does zhǐ mean? ("Paper".) Say it once more.

104.6 cídiǎn — dictionary

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pencil, then the Mandarin for paper.

You'll want to know: cídiǎn

cídiǎn — "dictionary".

wǒ yǒu yì běn hànyǔ cídiǎn — I've got a Chinese dictionary.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cídiǎn is built from cí 'words' and diǎn 'a standard work', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zi* and *tenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as a law and a classic.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: cídiǎn*
- *Say it: cídiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒu yì běn hànyǔ cídiǎn* — I've got a Chinese dictionary.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pencil, then the Mandarin for paper, then say *cídiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does cídiǎn mean? ("Dictionary".) Say it once more.

104.7 Looking back: from Getting Washed to On the Desk

Say the Mandarin for to wash and to brush one's teeth.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to wash, to brush one's teeth, to wash one's face, to have a shower, to comb one's hair
- *Say it:* bank, supermarket, park, library, post office
- *Say it:* kitchen, cabbage, chopsticks, plate, knife
- *Say it:* soft drink, juice, cola, beer, biscuit
- *Say it:* to use, to take hold of, to throw away, to repair, broken

- *Say it:* notebook, pen, pencil, paper, dictionary
- *Read it:* 洗 菜 用 本 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To wash? (洗, *xǐ.*) To brush one's teeth? (*shuāyá.*) To wash one's face? (*xǐliǎn.*) To have a shower? (*xǐzǎo.*) To comb one's hair? (*shūtóu.*) Bank? (*yínháng.*) Supermarket? (*chāoshì.*) Park? (*gōngyuán.*) Library? (*túshūguǎn.*) Post office? (*yóujú.*) Kitchen? (*chúfáng.*) Cabbage? (白菜, *báicài.*) Chopsticks? (*kuàizi.*) Plate? (*pánzi.*) Knife? (*dāo.*) Soft drink? (*yǐnliào.*) Juice? (*guǒzhī.*) Cola? (*kělè.*) Beer? (*píjiǔ.*) Biscuit? (*bǐnggān.*) To use? (用, *yòng.*) To take hold of? (*ná.*) To throw away? (*rēng.*) To repair? (*xiū.*) Broken? (*huài.*) Notebook? (本子, *běnzi.*) Pen? (*bǐ.*) Pencil? (*qiānbǐ.*) Paper? (*zhǐ.*) Dictionary? (*cídiǎn.*)

Chapter 105

In the Bathroom

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a towel, a toothbrush, toothpaste, soap and a mirror.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 105: I can name a towel, a toothbrush, toothpaste, soap and a mirror.*

105.1 máojīn — towel

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for paper, then the Mandarin for dictionary.

You'll want to know: máojīn

máojīn — "towel".

> *wǒ de máojīn hěn gānjìng* — My towel is clean.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

máojīn is built from máo and jīn, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maw* and *kin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as hair and fur and explains the second as a cloth worn on the head. How the pair came to mean a towel is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: máojīn*
- *Say it: máojīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de máojīn hěn gānjìng* — My towel is clean.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for paper, then the Mandarin for dictionary, then say *máojīn* again

Before you move on

What does máojīn mean? ("Towel".) Say it once more.

105.2 yáshuā — toothbrush

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dictionary, then the Mandarin for towel.

You'll want to know: yáshuā

yáshuā — "toothbrush".

wǒ de yáshuā zài nǎr — Where's my toothbrush?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yáshuā is built from yá 'tooth' and shuā 'brush', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngae* and *srwaet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the two parts of shuāyá, the other way round, make the thing.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yáshuā*
- *Say it: yáshuā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de yáshuā zài nǎr* — Where's my toothbrush?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dictionary, then the Mandarin for towel, then say *yáshuā* again

Before you move on

What does yáshuā mean? ("Toothbrush".) Say it once more.

105.3 yágāo — toothpaste

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for towel, then the Mandarin for toothbrush.

You'll want to know: yágāo

yágāo — "toothpaste".

méiyǒu yágāo le — We're out of toothpaste.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yágāo is built from yá 'tooth' and gāo 'paste', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngae* and *kaw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as fat or grease.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yágāo*
- *Say it: yágāo*, once more

- *Say it: méiyǒu yágāo le* — We're out of toothpaste.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for towel, then the Mandarin for toothbrush, then say *yágāo* again

Before you move on

What does yágāo mean? ("Toothpaste".) Say it once more.

105.4 féizào — soap

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for toothbrush, then the Mandarin for toothpaste.

You'll want to know: féizào

féizào — "soap".

yòng féizào xǐ shǒu — Wash your hands with soap.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

féizào is built from féi 'fat' and zào, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bj+j* and *dzawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'fleshy', and the second as black silk, among other senses; how the pair came to mean soap is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: féizào*
- *Say it: féizào*, once more
- *Say it: yòng féizào xǐ shǒu* — Wash your hands with soap.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for toothbrush, then the Mandarin for toothpaste, then say *féizào* again

Before you move on

What does féizào mean? (“Soap”.) Say it once more.

105.5 jìngzi — mirror

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for toothpaste, then the Mandarin for soap.

You’ll want to know: jìngzi

jìngzi — “mirror”.

xǐshǒujiān lǐ yǒu jìngzi ma — Is there a mirror in the toilets?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìngzi is built from jìng ’mirror’ and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription); the dictionary’s entry tells of a mirror sent as a gift to a king of old.

What you’ve built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìngzi*
- *Say it: jìngzi*, once more
- *Say it: xǐshǒujiān lǐ yǒu jìngzi ma* — Is there a mirror in the toilets?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for toothpaste, then the Mandarin for soap, then say *jìngzi* again

Before you move on

What does jìngzi mean? (“Mirror”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 106

Stops and Stations

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for the station, and talk about the metro, buses and bikes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 106: I can ask for the station, and talk about the metro, buses and bikes.*

106.1 车站 (chēzhàn) — station; stop

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for soap, then the Mandarin for mirror.

You'll want to know: 车站

车站 — *chēzhàn* — "station; stop".

> 车站在哪儿 *chēzhàn zài nǎr* — Where's the station?

The new character, in pieces: 站 — on the left a five-stroke piece read lì, 'to stand'; on the right a vertical with a short bar to its right, over 口. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

车站 (*chēzhàn*) is built from 车 'vehicle' and 站 'to stand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhae* and *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as an

everyday word for standing alone. A place where vehicles stand is the usual explanation, but the step is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēzhàn*
- *Say it: chēzhàn*, once more
- *Say it: chēzhàn zài nǎr* — Where's the station?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for soap, then the Mandarin for mirror, then say *chēzhàn* again

Before you move on

What does 车站 mean? ("Station; stop".) Say it once more.

106.2 站 — the standing piece, then a mark over 口

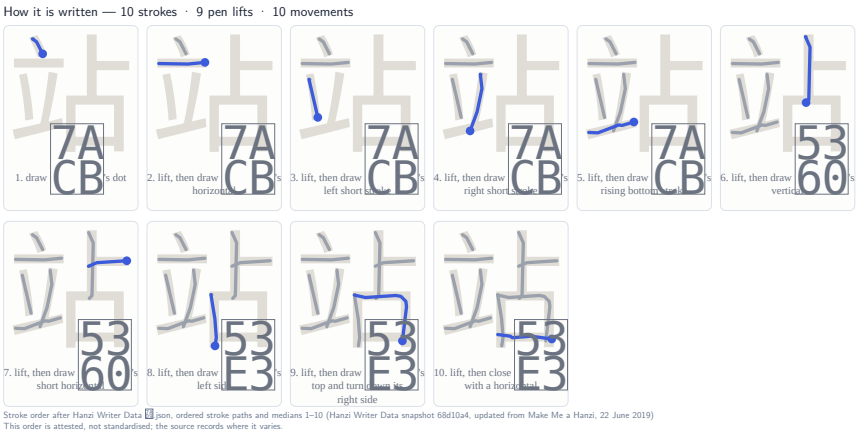
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chēzhàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  车 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *chē*, *kǒu*

Script — the standing piece, then a mark over 口



How 站 *is written, stroke by stroke*

站

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The standing piece, lì, five strokes: a dot at the top, a horizontal, a dot on the left and a short left-falling stroke on the right, and a stroke along the bottom that rises to the right.

The right piece, five strokes: a vertical with a short horizontal to its right; then 口 below, as you write it alone: the left side, the top that turns down, the bottom.

5 + 5 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 站, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 站? (**Two** — the standing piece, then the mark over 口.) What is the standing piece read? (*lì*.) Which piece you know ends 站? (口.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 站, pinned stroke paths and medians.

106.3 dìtiě — underground; metro

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for mirror, then the Mandarin for station.

You'll want to know: dìtiě

dìtiě — "underground; metro".

wǒmen zuò dìtiě qù — We'll take the metro.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìtiě is built from dì 'ground' and tiě 'iron', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *thet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as black metal. The railway under the ground is a modern sense.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìtiě*
- *Say it: dìtiě*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò dìtiě qù* — We'll take the metro.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for mirror, then the Mandarin for station, then say *dìtiě* again

Before you move on

What does dìtiě mean? ("Underground; metro".) Say it once more.

106.4 gōngjiāochē — city bus

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for station, then the Mandarin for metro.

You'll want to know: gōngjiāochē

gōngjiāochē — "city bus".

gōngjiāochē lái le — Here comes the bus.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngjiāochē is built from gōng 'public', jiāo 'to cross' and 车 'vehicle', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng*, *kaew* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The bus is a modern sense of the whole.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngjiāochē*
- *Say it: gōngjiāochē*, once more
- *Say it: gōngjiāochē lái le* — Here comes the bus.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for station, then the Mandarin for metro, then say *gōngjiāochē* again

Before you move on

What does gōngjiāochē mean? ("City bus".) Say it once more.

106.5 zìxíngchē — bicycle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for metro, then the Mandarin for bus.

You'll want to know: zìxíngchē

zìxíngchē — "bicycle".

> *zhè shì wǒ de zìxíngchē* — This is my bike.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zìxíngchē is built from zì 'self', xíng 'to go' and 车 'vehicle', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH*, *haeng* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses *haeng* 'to walk' and *dzijH* 'from'; the bicycle is a modern sense of the whole.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìxíngchē*
- *Say it: zìxíngchē*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de zìxíngchē* — This is my bike.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for metro, then the Mandarin for bus, then say *zìxíngchē* again

Before you move on

What does zìxíngchē mean? ("Bicycle".) Say it once more.

106.6 qí — to ride (a bike or a horse)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bus, then the Mandarin for bicycle.

You'll want to know: qí

qí — "to ride (a bike or a horse)".

> *wǒ qí zìxíngchē qù xuéxiào* — I ride my bike to school.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qí is inherited from Middle Chinese *gje* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to sit astride a horse'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: qí*
- *Say it: qí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qí zìxíngchē qù xuéxiào* — I ride my bike to school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bus, then the Mandarin for bicycle, then say *qí* again

Before you move on

What does qí mean? ("To ride (a bike or a horse)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

On the Move

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say jump, climb, carry, stop and leave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 107: I can say jump, climb, carry, stop and leave.*

107.1 tiào — to jump

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bicycle, then the Mandarin for to ride.

You'll want to know: tiào

tiào — "to jump".

> *wǒ de gǒu hěn xǐhuan tiào* — My dog loves jumping.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiào is inherited from Middle Chinese *dew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to leap'. The regular change from *dew* gives tiáo, with a rising tone, not the falling tiào of today; how it came to its tone is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiào*
- *Say it: tiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de gǒu hěn xǐhuan tiào* — My dog loves jumping.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bicycle, then the Mandarin for to ride, then say *tiào* again

Before you move on

What does tiào mean? ("To jump".) Say it once more.

107.2 pá — to climb; to crawl

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ride, then the Mandarin for to jump.

You'll want to know: pá

pá — "to climb; to crawl".

wǒmen míngtiān qù pá shān — We're going up into the hills tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pá is inherited from Middle Chinese *bae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to scratch'; how it came to mean to climb is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: pá*
- *Say it: pá*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen míngtiān qù pá shān* — We're going up into the hills tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ride, then the Mandarin for to jump, then say *pá* again

Before you move on

What does pá mean? ("To climb; to crawl".) Say it once more.

107.3 bān — to move house; to move (something heavy)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to jump, then the Mandarin for to climb.

You'll want to know: bān

bān — "to move house; to move (something heavy)".

nǐ néng bāng wǒ bān zhuōzi ma — Can you help me move the table?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bān has no older form on record under this character. The dictionary lists the same sound, *pan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), under an older character glossed 'to transport', which is probably the same word, though that is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: bān*
- *Say it: bān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ néng bāng wǒ bān zhuōzi ma* — Can you help me move the table?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to jump, then the Mandarin for to climb, then say *bān* again

Before you move on

What does bān mean? ("To move house; to move (something heavy)".) Say it once more.

107.4 tíng — to stop; to park

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to climb, then the Mandarin for to move house.

You'll want to know: tíng

tíng — "to stop; to park".

chē tíng le — The car has stopped.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tíng is inherited from Middle Chinese *deng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to rest', 'to settle' and 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíng*
- *Say it: tíng*, once more
- *Say it: chē tíng le* — The car has stopped.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to climb, then the Mandarin for to move house, then say *tíng* again

Before you move on

What does tíng mean? ("To stop; to park".) Say it once more.

107.5 líkāi — to leave a place

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to move house, then the Mandarin for to stop.

You'll want to know: líkāi

líkāi — "to leave a place".

wǒmen jǐ diǎn líkāi — What time are we leaving?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

líkāi is built from lí 'to part' and 开 'to open', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lje* and *khoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary says parting at a short distance is *lje*, at a long one is another word.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: líkāi*
- *Say it: líkāi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jǐ diǎn líkāi* — What time are we leaving?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to move house, then the Mandarin for to stop, then say *líkāi* again

Before you move on

What does líkāi mean? ("To leave a place".) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

Trying It On

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask to try something on, change it, and talk about pairs, sizes and fit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 108: I can ask to try something on, change it, and talk about pairs, sizes and fit.*

108.1 试 (shì) — to try; to try on

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stop, then the Mandarin for to leave a place.

You'll want to know: 试

试 — *shì* — "to try; to try on".

> 这个能试吗 *zhège néng shì ma* — Can I try this one on?

The new character, in pieces: 试 — the speech piece of 说 on the left; on the right six strokes: a horizontal across the top, a small three-stroke piece low under it, and a long stroke that slants down and hooks, with a dot at its top right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

试 (*shì*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *syiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to use'. Trying a thing by putting it to use is

the usual explanation, but the step is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: shì*
- *Say it: shì*, once more
- *Say it: zhège néng shì ma* — Can I try this one on?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stop, then the Mandarin for to leave a place, then say *shì* again

Before you move on

What does 试 mean? ("To try; to try on".) Say it once more.

108.2 试 — the speech piece, then a slanting hook

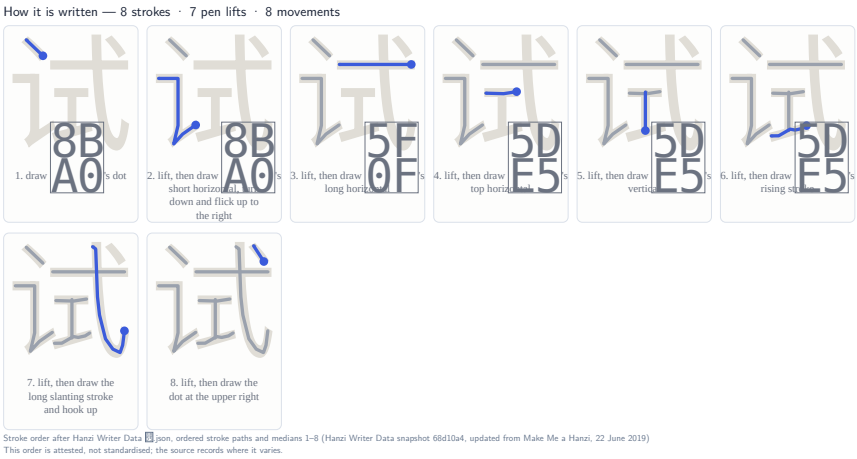
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  说 请

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shuō*, *qǐng*

Script — the speech piece, then a slanting hook



How 试 *is written, stroke by stroke*

试

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The speech piece, two strokes, as in 说: a dot, then a stroke across that turns down and rises.

The right piece, six strokes: a horizontal across the top; then, low on the left, a short horizontal, a vertical and a stroke that rises to the right; then one long stroke that slants down to the right and hooks up; and last a dot at the top right.

2 + 6 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 试, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 试? (**Two** — the speech piece, then the right piece.) Which characters you know start with the same piece? (说, 请, 课.) Which stroke comes last? (**The dot at the top right**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 试, pinned stroke paths and medians.

108.3 huàn — to change; to exchange

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leave a place, then the Mandarin for to try on.

You'll want to know: huàn

huàn — "to change; to exchange".

wǒ xiǎng huàn yí ge — I'd like to change it for another one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to exchange'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàn*
- *Say it: huàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng huàn yí ge* — I'd like to change it for another one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leave a place, then the Mandarin for to try on, then say *huàn* again

Before you move on

What does huàn mean? ("To change; to exchange".) Say it once more.

108.4 shuāng — a pair of (a measure word)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to try on, then the Mandarin for to exchange.

You'll want to know: shuāng

shuāng — "a pair of (a measure word)".

wǒ xiǎng mǎi yì shuāng xié — I'd like to buy a pair of shoes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuāng is inherited from Middle Chinese *sraewng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a pair, two of a kind'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuāng*
- *Say it: shuāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng mǎi yì shuāng xié* — I'd like to buy a pair of shoes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to try on, then the Mandarin for to exchange, then say *shuāng* again

Before you move on

What does shuāng mean? ("A pair of (a measure word)".) Say it once more.

108.5 大小 (dàxiǎo) — size

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to exchange, then the Mandarin for a pair of.

You'll want to know: 大小

大小 — *dàxiǎo* — "size".

> 我试了大小很好 *wǒ shì le dàxiǎo hěn hǎo* — I've tried it on, and the size is fine.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大小 (*dàxiǎo*) is built from 大 'big' and 小 'small', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *sjewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): how big or small a thing is.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàxiǎo*
- *Say it: dàxiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shì le dàxiǎo hěn hǎo* — I've tried it on, and the size is fine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to exchange, then the Mandarin for a pair of, then say *dàxiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 大小 mean? ("Size".) Say it once more.

108.6 héshì — right; suitable; a good fit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pair of, then the Mandarin for size.

You'll want to know: héshì

héshì — "right; suitable; a good fit".

> *zhè shuāng xié hěn héshì* — These shoes fit well.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

héshì is built from hé and shì, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hop* and *syek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to agree, to match' and the second 'good', among other senses.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: héshì*
- *Say it: héshì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shuāng xié hěn héshì* — These shoes fit well.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pair of, then the Mandarin for size, then say *héshì* again

Before you move on

What does héshì mean? ("Right; suitable; a good fit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 109

Screens

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about going online, the television, photos, charging and downloading.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 109: I can talk about going online, the television, photos, charging and downloading.*

109.1 上网 (shàngwǎng) — to go online

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for size, then the Mandarin for a good fit.

You'll want to know: 上网

上网 — *shàngwǎng* — "to go online".

> *nǐ měitiān shàngwǎng ma* — Do you go online every day?

The new character, in pieces: 网 — a frame open at the foot, like the outside of 两, with two small crosses inside. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上网 (*shàngwǎng*) is built from 上 'to go up, to get on' and wǎng 'net', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *mjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary describes the net as knotted

cord for hunting and fishing. Getting on to the net is a modern sense.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngwǎng*
- *Say it: shàngwǎng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ měitiān shàngwǎng ma* — Do you go online every day?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for size, then the Mandarin for a good fit, then say *shàngwǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 上网 mean? ("To go online".) Say it once more.

109.2 网 — the frame of 两, and two crosses

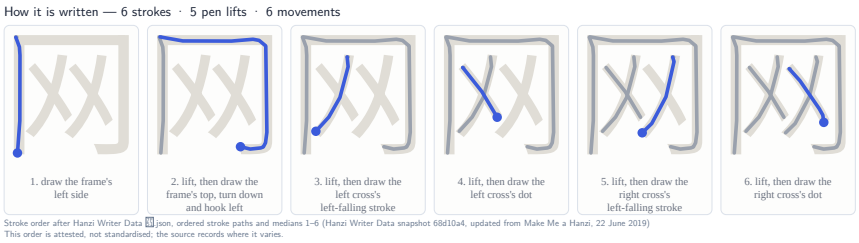
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shàngwǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  两 上

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *liǎng*, *shàng*

Script — the frame of 两, and two crosses



How 网 is written, stroke by stroke

网

The frame, two strokes, as in 两: a vertical down the left, then a stroke across the top that turns down the right side and hooks.

Two small crosses inside, two strokes each, left before right: a left-falling stroke, then a dot across it.

2 + 2 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 网, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 网? (**Six.**) Where have you written its frame? (**In 两.**) What is inside? (**Two small crosses, left one first.**) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 网, pinned stroke paths and medians.

109.3 diànshì — television

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a good fit, then the Mandarin for to go online.

You'll want to know: diànshì

diànshì — "television".

wǒ wǎnshang kàn diànshì — I watch TV in the evening.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diànshì is built from 电 'electricity' and shì 'to look', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *dzyijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as lightning. A modern

word.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: diànshì*
- *Say it: diànshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wǎnshang kàn diànshì* — I watch TV in the evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a good fit, then the Mandarin for to go online, then say *diànshì* again

Before you move on

What does diànshì mean? ("Television".) Say it once more.

109.4 zhàopiàn — photo; photograph

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go online, then the Mandarin for television.

You'll want to know: zhàopiàn

zhàopiàn — "photo; photograph".

zhè shì wǒ jiārén de zhàopiàn — This is a photo of my family.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhàopiàn is built from zhào and piàn, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyewH* and *phenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'bright' and the second as a piece of split wood. The photo is a modern sense of the pair.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhàopiàn*
- *Say it: zhàopiàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ jiārén de zhàopiàn* — This is a photo of my family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go online, then the Mandarin for television, then say *zhàopiàn* again

Before you move on

What does zhàopiàn mean? ("Photo; photograph".) Say it once more.

109.5 chōngdiàn — to charge a battery

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for television, then the Mandarin for photo.

You'll want to know: chōngdiàn

chōngdiàn — "to charge a battery".

wǒ de shǒujī xūyào chōngdiàn — My phone needs charging.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chōngdiàn is built from chōng 'to fill' and 电 'electricity', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhuwng* and *denH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to fill with electricity. A modern word.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chōngdiàn*
- *Say it: chōngdiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shǒujī xūyào chōngdiàn* — My phone needs charging.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for television, then the Mandarin for photo, then say *chōngdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does chōngdiàn mean? ("To charge a battery".) Say it once more.

109.6 xiàzài — to download

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for photo, then the Mandarin for to charge a battery.

You'll want to know: xiàzài

xiàzài — "to download".

nǐ xiàzài le ma — Have you downloaded it?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàzài is built from 下 'down' and zài 'to carry', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *dzojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to go down' and 'to transport'. A modern word.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàzài*
- *Say it: xiàzài*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xiàzài le ma* — Have you downloaded it?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for photo, then the Mandarin for to charge a battery, then say *xiàzài* again

Before you move on

What does xiàzài mean? ("To download".) Say it once more.

Chapter 110

Things I Can Do

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I speak a foreign language, play the piano, paint and dance.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 110: I can say I speak a foreign language, play the piano, paint and dance.*

110.1 外语 (wàiyǔ) — foreign language

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to charge a battery, then the Mandarin for to download.

You'll want to know: 外语

外语 — *wàiyǔ* — "foreign language".

> 我上网学外语 *wǒ shàngwǎng xué wàiyǔ* — I learn foreign languages online.

The new character, in pieces: 外 — on the left the three-stroke top half of 多; on the right a vertical with a dot beside it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

外语 (*wàiyǔ*) is built from 外 'outside' and 语 'speech', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *ngjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription): the speech from outside.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàiyǔ*
- *Say it: wàiyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shàngwǎng xué wàiyǔ* — I learn foreign languages online.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to charge a battery, then the Mandarin for to download, then say *wàiyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does 外语 mean? ("Foreign language".) Say it once more.

110.2 外 — the top of 多, then a vertical and a dot

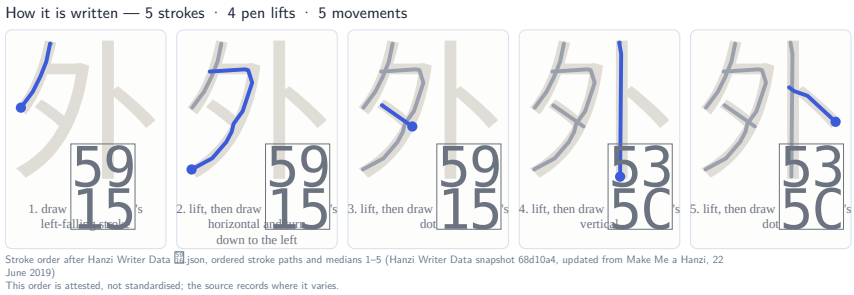
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wàiyǔ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  多 语

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *duō*, *yǔ*

Script — the top of 多, then a vertical and a dot



How 外 is written, stroke by stroke

外

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, three strokes, the top half of 多: a short left-falling stroke, a stroke across that turns and sweeps down to the left, and a dot inside.

The right piece, two strokes: a long vertical, and a dot to its right.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 外, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 外? (**Five.**) Where have you written its left piece? (**At the top of 多.**) What is on the right? (**A vertical and a dot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 外, pinned stroke paths and medians.

110.3 gāngqín — piano

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to download, then the Mandarin for foreign language.

You'll want to know: gāngqín

gāngqín — "piano".

tā jiā yǒu gāngqín — Her family has a piano.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gāngqín is built from gāng 'steel' and qín, a stringed instrument, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kang* and *gim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary describes the second as an instrument of five strings, later seven. The piano is a modern sense of the pair.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāngqín*
- *Say it: gāngqín*, once more
- *Say it: tā jiā yǒu gāngqín* — Her family has a piano.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to download, then the Mandarin for foreign language, then say *gāngqín* again

Before you move on

What does gāngqín mean? ("Piano".) Say it once more.

110.4 tán — to play an instrument; to pluck

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for foreign language, then the Mandarin for piano.

You'll want to know: tán

tán — "to play an instrument; to pluck".

wǒ huì tán gāngqín — I can play the piano.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tán is inherited from Middle Chinese *dan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to shoot' and named in a game of flicking pieces. Playing an instrument is not given there, so how the word came to that sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tán*
- *Say it: tán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ huì tán gāngqín* — I can play the piano.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for foreign language, then the Mandarin for piano, then say *tán* again

Before you move on

What does tán mean? ("To play an instrument; to pluck".) Say it once more.

110.5 huàhuà — to paint pictures; to draw

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for piano, then the Mandarin for to play an instrument.

You'll want to know: huàhuà

huàhuà — "to paint pictures; to draw".

> *háizi xǐhuan huàhuà* — Children love painting.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huàhuà is built from huà 'to paint' and its object huà 'a picture', one word used twice, inherited from Middle Chinese *hweaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary explains painting as laying the five colours on the likeness of things.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàhuà*
- *Say it: huàhuà*, once more
- *Say it: háizi xǐhuan huàhuà* — Children love painting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for piano, then the Mandarin for to play an instrument, then say *huàhuà* again

Before you move on

What does huàhuà mean? ("To paint pictures; to draw".) Say it once more.

110.6 tiàowǔ — to dance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to play an instrument, then the Mandarin for to paint pictures.

You'll want to know: tiàowǔ

tiàowǔ — "to dance".

nǐ xǐhuan tiàowǔ ma — Do you like dancing?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiàowǔ is built from tiào 'to leap' and wǔ 'dance', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dew* and *mjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as song and dance.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiàowǔ*
- *Say it: tiàowǔ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐhuan tiàowǔ ma* — Do you like dancing?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to play an instrument, then the Mandarin for to paint pictures, then say *tiàowǔ* again

Before you move on

What does tiàowǔ mean? ("To dance".) Say it once more.

110.7 Looking back: from In the Bathroom to Things I Can Do

Say the Mandarin for towel and toothbrush.

Your turn

- *Say it:* towel, toothbrush, toothpaste, soap, mirror
- *Say it:* station, metro, bus, bicycle, to ride

- *Say it:* to jump, to climb, to move house, to stop, to leave a place
- *Say it:* to try on, to exchange, a pair of, size, a good fit
- *Say it:* to go online, television, photo, to charge a battery, to download
- *Say it:* foreign language, piano, to play an instrument, to paint pictures, to dance
- *Read it:* 站 试 网 外 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Towel? (*máojīn.*) Toothbrush? (*yáshuā.*) Toothpaste? (*yágāo.*) Soap? (*féizào.*) Mirror? (*jìngzi.*) Station? (车站, *chēzhàn.*) Metro? (*dìtiě.*) Bus? (*gōngjiāochē.*) Bicycle? (*zìxíngchē.*) To ride? (*qí.*) To jump? (*tiào.*) To climb? (*pá.*) To move house? (*bān.*) To stop? (*tíng.*) To leave a place? (*líkāi.*) To try on? (试, *shì.*) To exchange? (*huàn.*) A pair of? (*shuāng.*) Size? (大小, *dàxiǎo.*) A good fit? (*héshì.*) To go online? (上网, *shàngwǎng.*) Television? (*diànshì.*) Photo? (*zhàopiàn.*) To charge a battery? (*chōngdiàn.*) To download? (*xiàzài.*) Foreign language? (外语, *wàiyǔ.*) Piano? (*gāngqín.*) To play an instrument? (*tán.*) To paint pictures? (*huàhuà.*) To dance? (*tiàowǔ.*)

Chapter 111

In Front and Behind

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say in front, behind, nearby and at the crossing, and say where to turn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 111: I can say in front, behind, nearby and at the crossing, and say where to turn.*

111.1 前边 (qiánbian) — in front; ahead

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to paint pictures, then the Mandarin for to dance.

You'll want to know: 前边

前边 — *qiánbian* — "in front; ahead".

> 前边是火车站 *qiánbian shì huǒchēzhàn* — The railway station is up ahead.

The new character, in pieces: 边 — lì, the foot of 男, inside the walking piece that runs down the left and along the foot of 这 and 进. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

前边 (*qiánbian*) is built from 前 'front' and 边 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzen* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'first, before' and the second 'an edge'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiánbian*
- *Say it: qiánbian*, once more
- *Say it: qiánbian shì huǒchēzhàn* — The railway station is up ahead.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to paint pictures, then the Mandarin for to dance, then say *qiánbian* again

Before you move on

What does 前边 mean? ("In front; ahead".) Say it once more.

111.2 边 — the foot of 男, inside the walking piece

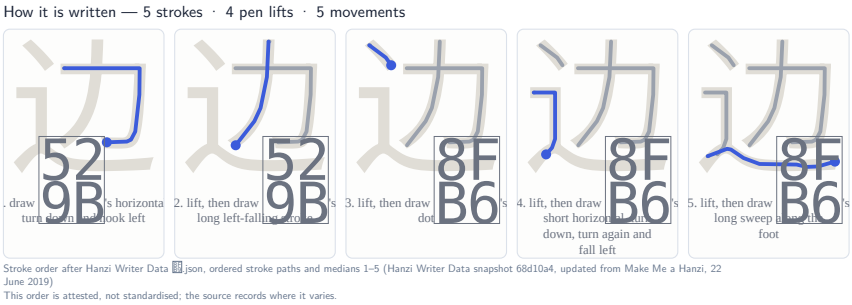
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qiánbian* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  男 这 进

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nán*, *zhè*, *jìn*

Script — the foot of 男, inside the walking piece



How 边 *is written, stroke by stroke*

边

The inside first, two strokes, the foot of 男: a stroke across that turns down and hooks, then a left-falling stroke through it.

The walking piece, three strokes, written last, as in 这 and 进: a dot, a small zigzag down the left, and a long flat sweep along the foot.

2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 边, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which comes first in 边, the inside or the walking piece? (**The inside**.) Where have you written that inside piece? (**At the foot of** 男.) Which characters you know end with the walking piece? (这 and 进.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 边, pinned stroke paths and medians.

111.3 hòubian — behind; at the back

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dance, then the Mandarin for in front.

You'll want to know: hòubian

hòubian — "behind; at the back".

> *xuéxiào hòubian yǒu yí ge gōngyuán* — There's a park behind the school.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hòubian is built from hòu 'behind' and 边 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòubian*
- *Say it: hòubian*, once more
- *Say it: xuéxiào hòubian yǒu yí ge gōngyuán* — There's a park behind the school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dance, then the Mandarin for in front, then say *hòubian* again

Before you move on

What does hòubian mean? ("Behind; at the back".) Say it once more.

111.4 fùjìn — nearby; in the area

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in front, then the Mandarin for at the back.

You'll want to know: fùjìn

fùjìn — "nearby; in the area".

fùjìn yǒu yínháng ma — Is there a bank near here?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fùjìn is built from fù 'to attach' and jìn 'near', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuH* and *gj+nX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùjìn*
- *Say it: fùjìn*, once more
- *Say it: fùjìn yǒu yínháng ma* — Is there a bank near here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in front, then the Mandarin for at the back, then say *fùjìn* again

Before you move on

What does fùjìn mean? ("Nearby; in the area".) Say it once more.

111.5 lùkǒu — crossroads; junction

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at the back, then the Mandarin for nearby.

You'll want to know: lùkǒu

lùkǒu — "crossroads; junction".

yínháng zài lùkǒu — The bank is at the crossroads.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lùkǒu is built from lù 'road' and 口 'mouth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luH* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the mouth of a road.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùkǒu*
- *Say it: lùkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: yínháng zài lùkǒu* — The bank is at the crossroads.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at the back, then the Mandarin for nearby, then say *lùkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does lùkǒu mean? ("Crossroads; junction".) Say it once more.

111.6 guǎi — to turn a corner

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for nearby, then the Mandarin for crossroads.

You'll want to know: guǎi

guǎi — "to turn a corner".

zhèr néng guǎi ma — Can we turn here?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǎi is inherited from Middle Chinese *kweaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as a stick, a thing for the hands and feet, probably a crutch; how it came to mean turning a corner is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǎi*
- *Say it: guǎi*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr néng guǎi ma* — Can we turn here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for nearby, then the Mandarin for crossroads, then say *guǎi* again

Before you move on

What does guǎi mean? ("To turn a corner".) Say it once more.

Chapter 112

Way In, Way Out

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the words on signs for the way out, the way in, push, pull and the stairs.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 112: I can say the words on signs for the way out, the way in, push, pull and the stairs.*

112.1 出口 (chūkǒu) — exit; way out

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for crossroads, then the Mandarin for to turn a corner.

You'll want to know: 出口

出口 — *chūkǒu* — "exit; way out".

> 出口在前边 *chūkǒu zài qiánbian* — The way out is up ahead.

The new character, in pieces: 出 — two halves like 山, one on top of the other, with one long vertical down through both. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出口 (*chūkǒu*) is built from 出 'to go out' and 口 'mouth, opening', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the opening you go out by.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūkǒu*
- *Say it: chūkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: chūkǒu zài qiánbian* — The way out is up ahead.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for crossroads, then the Mandarin for to turn a corner, then say *chūkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 出口 mean? ("Exit; way out".) Say it once more.

112.2 出 — two halves like 山, one long vertical

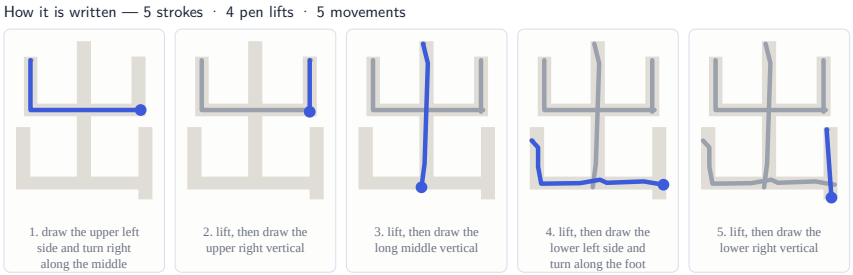
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chūkǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  山 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shān*, *kǒu*

Script — two halves like 山, one long vertical



How 出 is written, stroke by stroke

出

The top half, two strokes: a short vertical that turns right along its foot, then the short vertical on the right.

The long vertical, down the middle, through the top half and on into the bottom one.

The bottom half, two strokes, wider: a vertical that turns right along the foot, then the vertical on the right.

2 + 1 + 2 = five. Unlike 山, the middle vertical comes third.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 出, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 出? (**Five**.) Which stroke comes third? (**The long vertical down the middle**.) Which character you know does it look like, twice? (山.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 出, pinned stroke paths and medians.

112.3 rùkǒu — entrance; way in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn a corner, then the Mandarin for exit.

You'll want to know: rùkǒu

rùkǒu — "entrance; way in".

rùkǒu zài nàr — The way in is over there.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rùkǒu is built from rù 'to go in' and 口 'opening', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyip* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'inside, to take in' and 'mouth'.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: rùkǒu*
- *Say it: rùkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: rùkǒu zài nàr* — The way in is over there.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn a corner, then the Mandarin for exit, then say *rùkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does rùkǒu mean? ("Entrance; way in".) Say it once more.

112.4 tuī — to push

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for exit, then the Mandarin for entrance.

You'll want to know: tuī

tuī — "to push".

qǐng tuī mén — Push the door, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuī is inherited from Middle Chinese *thwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the character 'to push' under a second reading, *tsyhwij*, and lists *thwoj* beside it; tuī continues *thwoj*.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuī*
- *Say it: tuī*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng tuī mén* — Push the door, please.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for exit, then the Mandarin for entrance, then say *tuī* again

Before you move on

What does tuī mean? ("To push".) Say it once more.

112.5 lā — to pull

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for entrance, then the Mandarin for to push.

You'll want to know: lā

lā — "to pull".

bú yào tuī qǐng lā — Don't push, pull.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lā is inherited from Middle Chinese *lop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to break' and 'to crush'. The regular change from *lop* would give là, not lā, and pulling is not given there; how the word came to its sound and sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: lā*
- *Say it: lā*, once more
- *Say it: bú yào tuī qǐng lā* — Don't push, pull.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for entrance, then the Mandarin for to push, then say *lā* again

Before you move on

What does lā mean? ("To pull".) Say it once more.

112.6 lóutī — stairs; staircase

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to push, then the Mandarin for to pull.

You'll want to know: lóutī

lóutī — "stairs; staircase".

lóutī zài ménkǒu pángbiān — The stairs are next to the doorway.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lóutī is built from lóu and tī, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luw* and *thej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a house built on a house' and 'wooden steps'.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: lóutī*
- *Say it: lóutī*, once more

- *Say it: lóutī zài ménkǒu pángbiān* — The stairs are next to the doorway.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to push, then the Mandarin for to pull, then say *lóutī* again

Before you move on

What does lóutī mean? (“Stairs; staircase”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 113

Cooking

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say cut, boil, stir-fry, roast and fry.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 113: I can say cut, boil, stir-fry, roast and fry.

113.1 qiē — to cut; to slice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pull, then the Mandarin for stairs.

You'll want to know: qiē

qiē — "to cut; to slice".

wǒ qiē cài — I'll chop the vegetables.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiē is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to cut' and 'to carve'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiē*
- *Say it: qiē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qiē cài* — I'll chop the vegetables.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pull, then the Mandarin for stairs, then say *qiē* again

Before you move on

What does qiē mean? ("To cut; to slice".) Say it once more.

113.2 zhǔ — to boil; to cook in water

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for stairs, then the Mandarin for to slice.

You'll want to know: zhǔ

zhǔ — "to boil; to cook in water".

wǒmen zhǔ jiǎozi — We're boiling dumplings.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔ is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), listed under a variant form of the character and glossed 'to cook'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔ*
- *Say it: zhǔ*, once more

- *Say it: wǒmen zhǔ jiǎozi* — We're boiling dumplings.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for stairs, then the Mandarin for to slice, then say *zhǔ* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔ mean? ("To boil; to cook in water".) Say it once more.

113.3 chǎo — to stir-fry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to slice, then the Mandarin for to boil.

You'll want to know: chǎo

chǎo — "to stir-fry".

nǐ huì chǎo cài ma — Can you stir-fry vegetables?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsrhaewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to roast dry'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǎo*
- *Say it: chǎo*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ huì chǎo cài ma* — Can you stir-fry vegetables?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to slice, then the Mandarin for to boil, then say *chǎo* again

Before you move on

What does chǎo mean? ("To stir-fry".) Say it once more.

113.4 kǎo — to roast; to bake

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to boil, then the Mandarin for to stir-fry.

You'll want to know: kǎo

kǎo — "to roast; to bake".

wǒmen kǎo miànbāo — We're making toast.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kǎo is the everyday word for roasting and baking. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǎo*
- *Say it: kǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen kǎo miànbāo* — We're making toast.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to boil, then the Mandarin for to stir-fry, then say *kǎo* again

Before you move on

What does kǎo mean? ("To roast; to bake".) Say it once more.

113.5 jiān — to fry (in a little oil)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stir-fry, then the Mandarin for to roast.

You'll want to know: jiān

jiān — "to fry (in a little oil)".

wǒ huì jiān jīdàn — I can fry an egg.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiān is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to cook until done'. Frying in a little oil is the sense today; the step is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiān*
- *Say it: jiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ huì jiān jīdàn* — I can fry an egg.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stir-fry, then the Mandarin for to roast, then say *jiān* again

Before you move on

What does jiān mean? ("To fry (in a little oil)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 114

Paying

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for the bill, pay in cash or by card, and get my change.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 114: I can ask for the bill, pay in cash or by card, and get my change.*

114.1 mǎidān — to pay the bill

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to roast, then the Mandarin for to fry.

You'll want to know: mǎidān

mǎidān — "to pay the bill".

> *fúwùyuán mǎidān* — Excuse me, the bill, please!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǎidān is built from 买 'to buy' and dān, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *meaX* and *tan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'single'. Paying the bill is a modern sense, and how the pair came to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎidān*
- *Say it: mǎidān*, once more
- *Say it: fúwùyuán mǎidān* — Excuse me, the bill, please!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to roast, then the Mandarin for to fry, then say *mǎidān* again

Before you move on

What does mǎidān mean? ("To pay the bill".) Say it once more.

114.2 fù — to pay

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fry, then the Mandarin for to pay the bill.

You'll want to know: fù

fù — "to pay".

wǒ fù qián — I'll pay.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fù is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to give'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: fù*
- *Say it: fù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ fù qián* — I'll pay.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fry, then the Mandarin for to pay the bill, then say *fù* again

Before you move on

What does fù mean? ("To pay".) Say it once more.

114.3 xiànjīn — cash

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay the bill, then the Mandarin for to pay.

You'll want to know: xiànjīn

xiànjīn — "cash".

nǐ yǒu xiànjīn ma — Have you got any cash?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiànjīn is built from xiàn and jīn 'gold, money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *henH* and *kim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to show'; it is the xiàn of xiànzài 'now', and money there and then is the likely sense of the pair, though it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiànjīn*
- *Say it: xiànjīn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu xiànjīn ma* — Have you got any cash?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay the bill, then the Mandarin for to pay, then say *xiànjīn* again

Before you move on

What does xiànjīn mean? ("Cash".) Say it once more.

114.4 shuākǎ — to pay by card

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay, then the Mandarin for cash.

You'll want to know: shuākǎ

shuākǎ — "to pay by card".

wǒ kěyǐ shuākǎ ma — Can I pay by card?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
kěyǐ is said kéyǐ: two third tones, and the first rises.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuākǎ is built from shuā 'to brush, to swipe' and kǎ 'card'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *srwaet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the second is borrowed, usually traced to English *card*.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuākǎ*
- *Say it: shuākǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ kěyǐ shuākǎ ma* — Can I pay by card?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay, then the Mandarin for cash, then say *shuākǎ* again

Before you move on

What does shuākǎ mean? ("To pay by card".) Say it once more.

114.5 zhǎoqián — to give change

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cash, then the Mandarin for to pay by card.

You'll want to know: zhǎoqián

zhǎoqián — "to give change".

tā méiyǒu zhǎoqián — He didn't give me my change.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǎoqián is built from zhǎo 'to look for' and qián 'money'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎoqián*
- *Say it: zhǎoqián*, once more
- *Say it: tā méiyǒu zhǎoqián* — He didn't give me my change.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cash, then the Mandarin for to pay by card, then say *zhǎoqián* again

Before you move on

What does zhǎoqián mean? ("To give change".) Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Careful!

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say be careful, no smoking, pay attention and dangerous.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 115: I can say be careful, no smoking, pay attention and dangerous.*

115.1 小心 (xiǎoxīn) — to be careful; to mind (something)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay by card, then the Mandarin for to give change.

You'll want to know: 小心

小心 — *xiǎoxīn* — "to be careful; to mind (something)".

> 出门小心车 *chūmén xiǎoxīn chē* — Mind the traffic when you go out.

The new character, in pieces: 心 — four strokes: a dot, a long hook lying along the bottom, and two dots, the foot of 想. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小心 (*xiǎoxīn*) is built from 小 'small' and 心 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How a small heart came to mean care is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoxīn*
- *Say it: xiǎoxīn*, once more
- *Say it: chūmén xiǎoxīn chē* — Mind the traffic when you go out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay by card, then the Mandarin for to give change, then say *xiǎoxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 小心 mean? ("To be careful; to mind (something)".) Say it once more.

115.2 心 — a dot, a lying hook, two dots

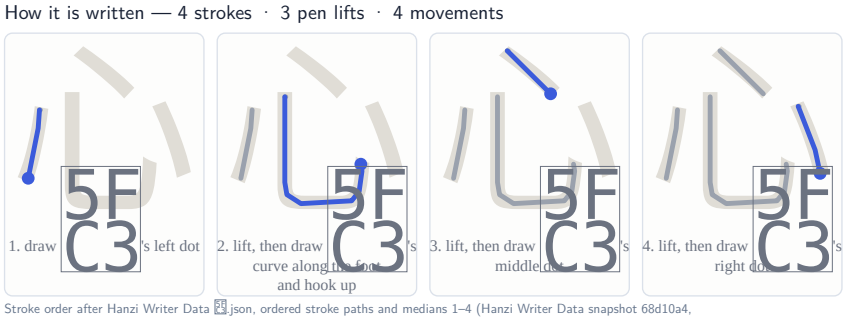
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiǎoxīn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  想 小

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xiǎng*, *xiǎo*

Script — a dot, a lying hook, two dots



How 忄 is written, stroke by stroke

忄

A dot on the left, slanting down.

A long hook lying along the bottom, curving up at the right and hooking in.

Two dots above it, the middle one, then the right one.

1 + 1 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 忄, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 忄? (**Four**.) Which stroke is the long one? (**The hook lying along the bottom, second**.) Where have you written it before? (**At the foot of 想**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 忄, pinned stroke paths and medians.

115.3 xīyān — to smoke

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give change, then the Mandarin for to be careful.

You'll want to know: xīyān

xīyān — "to smoke".

nǐ xīyān ma — Do you smoke?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīyān is built from xī 'to breathe in' and yān 'smoke', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xip* and *'en* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīyān*
- *Say it: xīyān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xīyān ma* — Do you smoke?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give change, then the Mandarin for to be careful, then say *xīyān* again

Before you move on

What does xīyān mean? ("To smoke".) Say it once more.

115.4 jìnzhǐ — to forbid; no (on signs)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be careful, then the Mandarin for to smoke.

You'll want to know: jìnzhǐ

jìnzhǐ — "to forbid; no (on signs)".

zhèr jìnzhǐ xīyān — No smoking here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìnzhǐ is built from jìn and zhǐ, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kimH* and *tsyiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and the dictionary glosses both 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnzhǐ*
- *Say it: jìnzhǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr jìnzhǐ xīyān* — No smoking here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be careful, then the Mandarin for to smoke, then say *jìnzhǐ* again

Before you move on

What does jìnzhǐ mean? ("To forbid; no (on signs)".) Say it once more.

115.5 zhùyì — to pay attention; to take care

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to smoke, then the Mandarin for to forbid.

You'll want to know: zhùyì

zhùyì — "to pay attention; to take care".

qǐng zhùyì nǐ de bāo — Please keep an eye on your bag.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhùyì is built from zhù 'to pour into' and yì 'mind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuH* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription): to pour the mind into something.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhùyì*
- *Say it: zhùyì*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng zhùyì nǐ de bāo* — Please keep an eye on your bag.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to smoke, then the Mandarin for to forbid, then say *zhùyì* again

Before you move on

What does zhùyì mean? ("To pay attention; to take care".) Say it once more.

115.6 wēixiǎn — dangerous

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to forbid, then the Mandarin for to pay attention.

You'll want to know: wēixiǎn

wēixiǎn — "dangerous".

zhèr hěn wēixiǎn — It's dangerous here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wēixiǎn is built from wēi and xiǎn, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwe* and *xjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'unsafe' and 'perilous, hard to pass'. The regular change from *ngjwe* gives wéi, with a rising tone; the level wēi of today is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: wēixiǎn*
- *Say it: wēixiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr hěn wēixiǎn* — It's dangerous here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to forbid, then the Mandarin for to pay attention, then say *wēixiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does wēixiǎn mean? ("Dangerous".) Say it once more.

Chapter 116

Things I Carry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I have my wallet, passport, watch and umbrella, and say I have lost something.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 116: I can say I have my wallet, passport, watch and umbrella, and say I have lost something.*

116.1 qiánbāo — wallet; purse

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay attention, then the Mandarin for dangerous.

You'll want to know: qiánbāo

qiánbāo — "wallet; purse".

> *wǒ de qiánbāo zài bāo lǐ* — My wallet's in my bag.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiánbāo is built from qián 'money' and bāo 'to wrap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjen* and *paew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiánbāo*
- *Say it: qiánbāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de qiánbāo zài bāo lǐ* — My wallet's in my bag.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay attention, then the Mandarin for dangerous, then say *qiánbāo* again

Before you move on

What does qiánbāo mean? ("Wallet; purse".) Say it once more.

116.2 hùzhào — passport

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dangerous, then the Mandarin for wallet.

You'll want to know: hùzhào

hùzhào — "passport".

nǐ dài hùzhào le ma — Have you brought your passport?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hùzhào is built from hù 'to protect' and zhào 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huH* and *tsyewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The passport is a modern sense of the pair, and how it came to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: hùzhào*
- *Say it: hùzhào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ dài hùzhào le ma* — Have you brought your passport?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dangerous, then the Mandarin for wallet, then say *hùzhào* again

Before you move on

What does hùzhào mean? ("Passport".) Say it once more.

116.3 shǒubiǎo — wristwatch

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for wallet, then the Mandarin for passport.

You'll want to know: shǒubiǎo

shǒubiǎo — "wristwatch".

nǐ de shǒubiǎo hěn hǎokàn — Your watch is lovely.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: shǒu rises before biǎo, and is still written shǒu.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǒubiǎo is built from 手 'hand' and biǎo, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *pjewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'to make clear' and 'an outer garment'. The watch is a modern sense, and how biǎo came to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒubiǎo*
- *Say it: shǒubiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de shǒubiǎo hěn hǎokàn* — Your watch is lovely.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for wallet, then the Mandarin for passport, then say *shǒubiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does shǒubiǎo mean? ("Wristwatch".) Say it once more.

116.4 yǔsǎn — umbrella

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for passport, then the Mandarin for wristwatch.

You'll want to know: yǔsǎn

yǔsǎn — "umbrella".

xiàyǔ le nǐ dài yǔsǎn le ma — It's raining; have you got an umbrella?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: yǔ rises before sǎn, and is still written yǔ.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǔsǎn is built from 雨 'rain' and sǎn, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuX* and *sanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as a canopy.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǔsǎn*
- *Say it: yǔsǎn*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ le nǐ dài yǔsǎn le ma* — It's raining; have you got an umbrella?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for passport, then the Mandarin for wristwatch, then say *yǔsǎn* again

Before you move on

What does yǔsǎn mean? ("Umbrella".) Say it once more.

116.5 diū — to lose (a thing)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for wristwatch, then the Mandarin for umbrella.

You'll want to know: diū

diū — "to lose (a thing)".

wǒ de yàoshi diū le — I've lost my keys.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diū is the everyday verb for losing a thing. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: diū*
- *Say it: diū*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ de yàoshi diū le* — I've lost my keys.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for wristwatch, then the Mandarin for umbrella, then say *diū* again

Before you move on

What does diū mean? ("To lose (a thing)".) Say it once more.

116.6 Looking back: from In Front and Behind to Things I Carry

Say the Mandarin for in front and at the back.

Your turn

- *Say it:* in front, at the back, nearby, crossroads, to turn a corner
- *Say it:* exit, entrance, to push, to pull, stairs
- *Say it:* to slice, to boil, to stir-fry, to roast, to fry
- *Say it:* to pay the bill, to pay, cash, to pay by card, to give change
- *Say it:* to be careful, to smoke, to forbid, to pay attention, dangerous
- *Say it:* wallet, passport, wristwatch, umbrella, to lose
- *Read it:* 边 出 心 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

In front? (前边, *qiánbian.*) At the back? (*hòubian.*) Nearby? (*fùjìn.*) Crossroads? (*lùkǒu.*) To turn a corner? (*guǎi.*) Exit? (出口, *chūkǒu.*) Entrance? (*rùkǒu.*) To push? (*tuī.*) To pull? (*lā.*) Stairs? (*lóutī.*) To slice? (*qiē.*) To boil? (*zhǔ.*) To stir-fry? (*chǎo.*) To roast? (*kǎo.*) To fry? (*jiān.*) To pay the bill? (*mǎidān.*) To pay? (*fù.*) Cash? (*xiànjīn.*) To pay by card? (*shuākǎ.*) To give change? (*zhǎoqián.*) To be careful? (小心, *xiǎoxīn.*) To smoke? (*xīyān.*) To forbid? (*jìnzhǐ.*) To pay attention? (*zhùyì.*) Dangerous? (*wēixiǎn.*) Wallet? (*qiánbāo.*) Passport? (*hùzhào.*) Wristwatch? (*shǒubiǎo.*) Umbrella? (*yǔsǎn.*) To lose? (*diū.*)

Chapter 117

Which Way?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say east, south, west and north, and ask which way to go.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 117: I can say east, south, west and north, and ask which way to go.*

117.1 dōngbian — the east; on the east side

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for umbrella, then the Mandarin for to lose.

You'll want to know: dōngbian

dōngbian — "the east; on the east side".

> *chēzhàn zài dōngbian* — The station is on the east side.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dōngbian is built from dōng 'east' and 边 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tuwng* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary calls the east the direction of spring, and repeats an old reading of the character as the sun inside a tree.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōngbian*
- *Say it: dōngbian*, once more
- *Say it: chēzhàn zài dōngbian* — The station is on the east side.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for umbrella, then the Mandarin for to lose, then say *dōngbian* again

Before you move on

What does dōngbian mean? ("The east; on the east side".) Say it once more.

117.2 nánbian — the south; on the south side

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lose, then the Mandarin for the east.

You'll want to know: nánbian

nánbian — "the south; on the south side".

gōngyuán zài nánbian — The park is to the south.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nánbian is built from nán 'south' and 边 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nom* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary calls the south the direction of fire.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánbian*
- *Say it: nánbian*, once more
- *Say it: gōngyuán zài nánbian* — The park is to the south.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lose, then the Mandarin for the east, then say *nánbian* again

Before you move on

What does nánbian mean? ("The south; on the south side".) Say it once more.

117.3 xībian — the west; on the west side

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the east, then the Mandarin for the south.

You'll want to know: xībian

xībian — "the west; on the west side".

xībian yǒu shān — There are hills to the west.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xībian is built from xī 'west' and 边 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sej* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary calls the west the direction of autumn, and explains the character as a bird settling on its nest when the sun is in the west.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: xībian*
- *Say it: xībian*, once more
- *Say it: xībian yǒu shān* — There are hills to the west.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the east, then the Mandarin for the south, then say *xībian* again

Before you move on

What does xībian mean? ("The west; on the west side".) Say it once more.

117.4 běibian — the north; on the north side

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the south, then the Mandarin for the west.

You'll want to know: běibian

běibian — "the north; on the north side".

Běijīng zài Zhōngguó de běibian — Beijing is in the north of China.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

běibian is built from běi 'north' and 边 'side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pok* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: běibian*
- *Say it: běibian*, once more
- *Say it: Běijīng zài Zhōngguó de běibian* — Beijing is in the north of China.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the south, then the Mandarin for the west, then say *běibian* again

Before you move on

What does běibian mean? ("The north; on the north side".) Say it once more.

117.5 fāngxiàng — direction; way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the west, then the Mandarin for the north.

You'll want to know: fāngxiàng

fāngxiàng — "direction; way".

chēzhàn zài nǎge fāngxiàng — Which way is the station?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāngxiàng is built from fāng 'side, region' and xiàng 'to face', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjang* and *xjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the side you face.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāngxiàng*
- *Say it: fāngxiàng*, once more
- *Say it: chēzhàn zài nǎge fāngxiàng* — Which way is the station?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the west, then the Mandarin for the north, then say *fāngxiàng* again

Before you move on

What does fāngxiàng mean? ("Direction; way".) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Sending Things

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can post a parcel, talk about letters and text messages, and say receive.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 118: I can post a parcel, talk about letters and text messages, and say receive.*

118.1 bāoguǒ — parcel; package

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the north, then the Mandarin for direction.

You'll want to know: bāoguǒ

bāoguǒ — "parcel; package".

> *zhège bāoguǒ shì nǐ de ma* — Is this parcel yours?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bāoguǒ is built from bāo and guǒ, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *paew* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'to wrap, to bind', and gives the pair itself as the gloss of the first.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāoguǒ*
- *Say it: bāoguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: zhège bāoguǒ shì nǐ de ma* — Is this parcel yours?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the north, then the Mandarin for direction, then say *bāoguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does bāoguǒ mean? ("Parcel; package".) Say it once more.

118.2 jì — to post; to send by post

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for direction, then the Mandarin for parcel.

You'll want to know: jì

jì — "to post; to send by post".

wǒ qù yóujú jì bāoguǒ — I'm going to the post office to send a parcel.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jì is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to entrust to someone'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: jì*
- *Say it: jì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù yóujú jì bāoguǒ* — I'm going to the post office to send a parcel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for direction, then the Mandarin for parcel, then say *jì* again

Before you move on

What does jì mean? ("To post; to send by post".) Say it once more.

118.3 xìn — letter (in the post)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for parcel, then the Mandarin for to post.

You'll want to know: xìn

xìn — "letter (in the post)".

wǒ xiǎng gěi péngyou xiě xìn — I'd like to write to a friend.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìn is inherited from Middle Chinese *sinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'trust' and 'proof'; how it came to mean a letter is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìn*
- *Say it: xìn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng gěi péngyou xiě xìn* — I'd like to write to a friend.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for parcel, then the Mandarin for to post, then say *xìn* again

Before you move on

What does xìn mean? ("Letter (in the post)".) Say it once more.

118.4 duǎnxìn — text message

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to post, then the Mandarin for letter.

You'll want to know: duǎnxìn

duǎnxìn — "text message".

wǒ gěi māma xiě duǎnxìn — I'm writing a text to my mum.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duǎnxìn is built from duǎn 'short' and xìn 'letter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *twanX* and *sinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a short letter.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: duǎnxìn*
- *Say it: duǎnxìn*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ gěi māma xiě duǎnxìn* — I'm writing a text to my mum.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to post, then the Mandarin for letter, then say *duǎnxìn* again

Before you move on

What does duǎnxìn mean? ("Text message".) Say it once more.

118.5 shōu — to receive; to accept

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for letter, then the Mandarin for text message.

You'll want to know: shōu

shōu — "to receive; to accept".

tā bù shōu qián — He won't take any money.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōu is inherited from Middle Chinese *syuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to gather in' and 'to seize'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōu*
- *Say it: shōu*, once more
- *Say it: tā bù shōu qián* — He won't take any money.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for letter, then the Mandarin for text message, then say *shōu* again

Before you move on

What does shōu mean? (“To receive; to accept”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Bags and Boxes

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a schoolbag, a suitcase, a box, a carrier bag and luggage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 119: I can name a schoolbag, a suitcase, a box, a carrier bag and luggage.*

119.1 书包 (shūbāo) — schoolbag

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for text message, then the Mandarin for to receive.

You'll want to know: 书包

书包 — *shūbāo* — "schoolbag".

> 我的书包里有两本书 *wǒ de shūbāo lǐ yǒu liǎng běn shū* — There are two books in my schoolbag.

The new character, in pieces: 包 — a wrapping stroke that bends round from the top, and inside it three strokes: a turn, a short bar, and a vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

书包 (*shūbāo*) is built from 书 'book' and 包 'to wrap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syo* and *paew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a wrapper for books.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūbāo*
- *Say it: shūbāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shūbāo lǐ yǒu liǎng běn shū* — There are two books in my schoolbag.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for text message, then the Mandarin for to receive, then say *shūbāo* again

Before you move on

What does 书包 mean? ("Schoolbag".) Say it once more.

119.2 包 — a wrapping stroke, and three strokes inside

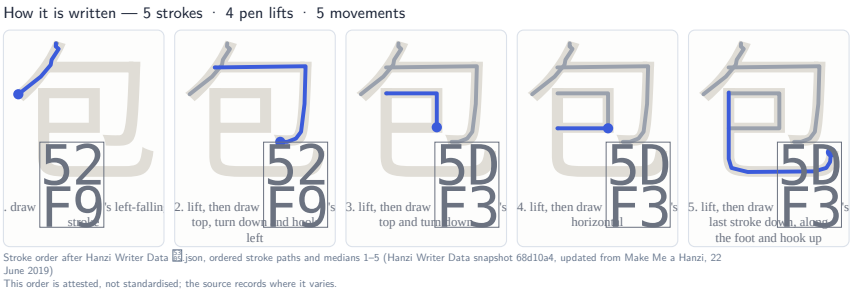
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shūbāo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  书 也

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shū*, *yě*

Script — a wrapping stroke, and three strokes inside



How 包 *is written, stroke by stroke*

包

The wrapping piece, two strokes: a short left-falling stroke, then a stroke across that turns down the right side and hooks.

The inside, three strokes: a stroke across that turns down, a short horizontal under it, and a vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up, out past the wrapping, as the last stroke of 也 does.

2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 包, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 包? (**Five**.) Which piece comes first, the wrapping or the inside? (**The wrapping**.) Which character you know ends with the same stroke? (也.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 包, pinned stroke paths and medians.

119.3 xiāngzi — box; suitcase; trunk

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to receive, then the Mandarin for schoolbag.

You'll want to know: xiāngzi

xiāngzi — "box; suitcase; trunk".

> *zhège xiāngzi tài dà le* — This suitcase is too big.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāngzi is built from xiāng and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjang* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a box or a hamper.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāngzi*
- *Say it: xiāngzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xiāngzi tài dà le* — This suitcase is too big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to receive, then the Mandarin for schoolbag, then say *xiāngzi* again

Before you move on

What does xiāngzi mean? ("Box; suitcase; trunk".) Say it once more.

119.4 hézi — box; small case

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for schoolbag, then the Mandarin for suitcase.

You'll want to know: hézi

hézi — "box; small case".

hézi lǐ yǒu shénme — What's in the box?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hézi is built from hé and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hop* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a dish with a lid.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: hézi*
- *Say it: hézi*, once more
- *Say it: hézi lǐ yǒu shénme* — What's in the box?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for schoolbag, then the Mandarin for suitcase, then say *hézi* again

Before you move on

What does hézi mean? ("Box; small case".) Say it once more.

119.5 dàizi — bag; sack

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for suitcase, then the Mandarin for small box.

You'll want to know: dàizi

dàizi — "bag; sack".

nǐ xūyào dàizi ma — Do you need a bag?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàizi is built from dài and the noun ending zi, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dojH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a kind of sack.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàizi*
- *Say it: dàizi*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xūyào dàizi ma* — Do you need a bag?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for suitcase, then the Mandarin for small box, then say *dàizi* again

Before you move on

What does dàizi mean? ("Bag; sack".) Say it once more.

119.6 xíngli — luggage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for small box, then the Mandarin for carrier bag.

You'll want to know: xíngli

xíngli — "luggage".

nǐ de xíngli zài nǎr — Where's your luggage?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xíngli is built from xíng 'to go' and lǐ 'plum', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeng* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the pair itself under the second, but how 'plum'

came into a word for luggage is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xíngli*
- *Say it: xíngli*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de xíngli zài nǎr* — Where's your luggage?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for small box, then the Mandarin for carrier bag, then say *xíngli* again

Before you move on

What does xíngli mean? ("Luggage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 120

Takeaway

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can order a takeaway, give my address, ask to take food home, and ask for dim sum.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 120: I can order a takeaway, give my address, ask to take food home, and ask for dim sum.*

120.1 wàimài — takeaway; food delivered

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for carrier bag, then the Mandarin for luggage.

You'll want to know: wàimài

wàimài — "takeaway; food delivered".

> *wǒmen jīntiān wǎnshang chī wàimài* — We're having a takeaway tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàimài is built from 外 'outside' and mài 'to sell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *meaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): food sold to be eaten somewhere else.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàimài*
- *Say it: wàimài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jīntiān wǎnshang chī wàimài* — We're having a takeaway tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for carrier bag, then the Mandarin for luggage, then say *wàimài* again

Before you move on

What does wàimài mean? ("Takeaway; food delivered".) Say it once more.

120.2 dìng — to make a booking; to order

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for luggage, then the Mandarin for takeaway.

You'll want to know: dìng

dìng — "to make a booking; to order".

wǒ xiǎng dìng yí ge fángjiān — I'd like to book a room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìng is inherited from Middle Chinese *dengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to discuss and settle', which regularly gives dìng. Booking is the sense today, probably by way of settling an arrangement, but the step is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìng*
- *Say it: dìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng dìng yí ge fángjiān* — I'd like to book a room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for luggage, then the Mandarin for takeaway, then say *dìng* again

Before you move on

What does dìng mean? ("To make a booking; to order".) Say it once more.

120.3 dìzhǐ — address

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for takeaway, then the Mandarin for to make a booking.

You'll want to know: dìzhǐ

dìzhǐ — "address".

nǐ jiā de dìzhǐ shì shénme — What's your home address?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìzhǐ is built from dì 'ground' and zhǐ 'site', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *tsyiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as the foundation of a building.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìzhǐ*
- *Say it: dìzhǐ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ jiā de dìzhǐ shì shénme* — What's your home address?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for takeaway, then the Mandarin for to make a booking, then say *dìzhǐ* again

Before you move on

What does dìzhǐ mean? ("Address".) Say it once more.

120.4 打包 (dǎbāo) — to pack food to take away

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a booking, then the Mandarin for address.

You'll want to know: 打包

打包 — *dǎbāo* — "to pack food to take away".

我想打包 *wǒ xiǎng dǎbāo* — Could I take this away?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

打包 (*dǎbāo*) is built from 打 'to strike, to do' and 包 'to wrap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *paew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to strike'; dǎ is not the sound *taengX* would regularly give, and its everyday sense of doing is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎbāo*
- *Say it: dǎbāo*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng dǎbāo* — Could I take this away?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a booking, then the Mandarin for address, then say *dǎbāo* again

Before you move on

What does 打包 mean? ("To pack food to take away".) Say it once more.

120.5 点心 (diǎnxin) — dim sum; light snacks and pastries

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for address, then the Mandarin for to pack food to take away.

You'll want to know: 点心

点心 — *diǎnxin* — "dim sum; light snacks and pastries".

我们去外边吃点心 *wǒmen qù wàibian chī diǎnxin* — We're going out for dim sum.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

点心 (*diǎnxin*) is built from 点 'a dot, a little' and 心 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *temX* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a dot made with the brush. How the pair came to mean a light snack is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: diǎnxin*
- *Say it: diǎnxin*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù wàibian chī diǎnxin* — We're going out for dim sum.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for address, then the Mandarin for to pack food to take away, then say *diǎnxin* again

Before you move on

What does 点心 mean? ("Dim sum; light snacks and pastries".) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Teaching and Practising

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say teach, practise, answer and revise, and say something is wrong.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 121: I can say teach, practise, answer and revise, and say something is wrong.*

121.1 jiāo — to teach

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pack food to take away, then the Mandarin for dim sum.

You'll want to know: jiāo

jiāo — "to teach".

> *tā jiāo wǒ hànyǔ* — She teaches me Chinese.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāo is inherited from Middle Chinese *kaewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to teach'; the dictionary also lists the character with a level tone, *kaew*, glossed 'to imitate', and the level jiāo of the verb matches that one.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāo*
- *Say it: jiāo*, once more
- *Say it: tā jiāo wǒ hànyǔ* — She teaches me Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pack food to take away, then the Mandarin for dim sum, then say *jiāo* again

Before you move on

What does jiāo mean? ("To teach".) Say it once more.

121.2 liànxí — to practise

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dim sum, then the Mandarin for to teach.

You'll want to know: liànxí

liànxí — "to practise".

wǒ měitiān liànxí shuō hànyǔ — I practise speaking Chinese every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liànxí is built from liàn and xí, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lenH* and *zip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as white boiled silk and the second 'to learn', explaining it as flying again and again.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: liànxí*
- *Say it: liànxí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān liànxí shuō hànyǔ* — I practise speaking Chinese every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dim sum, then the Mandarin for to teach, then say *liànxí* again

Before you move on

What does liànxí mean? ("To practise".) Say it once more.

121.3 huídá — to answer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to teach, then the Mandarin for to practise.

You'll want to know: huídá

huídá — "to answer".

qǐng nǐ huídá — Please answer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huídá is built from huí 'to turn back' and dá 'to respond', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *top* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'to match'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: huídá*
- *Say it: huídá*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng nǐ huídá* — Please answer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to teach, then the Mandarin for to practise, then say *huídá* again

Before you move on

What does huídá mean? ("To answer".) Say it once more.

121.4 fùxí — to revise; to go over again

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to practise, then the Mandarin for to answer.

You'll want to know: fùxí

fùxí — "to revise; to go over again".

wǒ wǎnshang fùxí hànyǔ — I go over my Chinese in the evening.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fùxí is built from fù 'again' and xí 'to learn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuwk* and *zip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to learn again. The dictionary glosses the first 'to return, to repeat' and lists it with a departing tone too, *bjuwH*, glossed 'again': fù continues that one, since the regular change from *bjuwk* gives fú.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùxí*
- *Say it: fùxí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wǎnshang fùxí hànyǔ* — I go over my Chinese in the evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to practise, then the Mandarin for to answer, then say *fùxí* again

Before you move on

What does fùxí mean? ("To revise; to go over again".) Say it once more.

121.5 cuò — wrong; mistaken

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to answer, then the Mandarin for to revise.

You'll want to know: cuò

cuò — "wrong; mistaken".

zhège hànzì cuò le — This character is wrong.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cuò is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'mixed' and 'crossing slantwise'; how it came to mean wrong is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuò*
- *Say it: cuò*, once more
- *Say it: zhège hànzì cuò le* — This character is wrong.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to answer, then the Mandarin for to revise, then say *cuò* again

Before you move on

What does cuò mean? ("Wrong; mistaken".) Say it once more.

Chapter 122

Opening Hours

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say open for business, start, finish, discount and timetable.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 122: I can say open for business, start, finish, discount and timetable.*

122.1 yíngyè — to be open for business

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to revise, then the Mandarin for wrong.

You'll want to know: yíngyè

yíngyè — "to be open for business".

> *shāngdiàn jǐ diǎn yíngyè* — What time does the shop open?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yíngyè is built from yíng and yè, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yweng* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to build, to plan' and 'affairs'.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíngyè*
- *Say it: yíngyè*, once more
- *Say it: shāngdiàn jǐ diǎn yíngyè* — What time does the shop open?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to revise, then the Mandarin for wrong, then say *yíngyè* again

Before you move on

What does yíngyè mean? ("To be open for business".) Say it once more.

122.2 kāishǐ — to begin; to start

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for wrong, then the Mandarin for to be open for business.

You'll want to know: kāishǐ

kāishǐ — "to begin; to start".

wǒmen jǐ diǎn kāishǐ — What time do we start?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāishǐ is built from 开 'to open' and shǐ 'beginning', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *syiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāishǐ*
- *Say it: kāishǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jǐ diǎn kāishǐ* — What time do we start?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for wrong, then the Mandarin for to be open for business, then say *kāishǐ* again

Before you move on

What does kāishǐ mean? ("To begin; to start".) Say it once more.

122.3 jiéshù — to come to an end; to finish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be open for business, then the Mandarin for to begin.

You'll want to know: jiéshù

jiéshù — "to come to an end; to finish".

kè jǐ diǎn jiéshù — What time does the lesson finish?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiéshù is built from jié 'to tie' and shù 'to bind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ket* and *syowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiéshù*
- *Say it: jiéshù*, once more

- *Say it: kè jǐ diǎn jiéshù* — What time does the lesson finish?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be open for business, then the Mandarin for to begin, then say *jiéshù* again

Before you move on

What does jiéshù mean? ("To come to an end; to finish".) Say it once more.

122.4 shíkèbiǎo — timetable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to begin, then the Mandarin for to come to an end.

You'll want to know: shíkèbiǎo

shíkèbiǎo — "timetable".

wǒ yǒu yì zhāng huǒchē shíkèbiǎo — I've got a train timetable.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shíkèbiǎo is built from 时 'time', kè 'a notch, a quarter of an hour' and biǎo 'table', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyi*, *khok* and *pjewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'to carve' and the third 'to make clear'.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: shíkèbiǎo*
- *Say it: shíkèbiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒu yì zhāng huǒchē shíkèbiǎo* — I've got a train timetable.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to begin, then the Mandarin for to come to an end, then say *shíkèbiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does shíkèbiǎo mean? ("Timetable".) Say it once more.

122.5 dǎzhé — to give a discount; to be on sale

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come to an end, then the Mandarin for timetable.

You'll want to know: dǎzhé

dǎzhé — "to give a discount; to be on sale".

zhège xīngqī dǎzhé — Things are on sale this week.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎzhé is built from 打 'to strike, to do' and zhé, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *tsyet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'to bend and break'. How the pair came to mean a discount is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for signs and notices.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎzhé*
- *Say it: dǎzhé*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xīngqī dǎzhé* — Things are on sale this week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come to an end, then the Mandarin for timetable, then say *dǎzhé* again

Before you move on

What does dǎzhé mean? ("To give a discount; to be on sale".) Say it once more.

122.6 Looking back: from Which Way? to Opening Hours

Say the Mandarin for the east and the south.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the east, the south, the west, the north, direction
- *Say it:* parcel, to post, letter, text message, to receive
- *Say it:* schoolbag, suitcase, small box, carrier bag, luggage
- *Say it:* takeaway, to make a booking, address, to pack food to take away, dim sum
- *Say it:* to teach, to practise, to answer, to revise, wrong
- *Say it:* to be open for business, to begin, to come to an end, timetable, to give a discount
- *Read it:* 包 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The east? (*dōngbian.*) The south? (*nánbian.*) The west? (*xībian.*) The north? (*běibian.*) Direction? (*fāngxiàng.*) Parcel? (*bāoguǒ.*) To post? (*jì.*) Letter? (*xìn.*) Text message? (*duǎnxìn.*) To receive? (*shōu.*) Schoolbag? (书包, *shūbāo.*) Suitcase? (*xiāngzi.*) Small box? (*hézi.*) Carrier bag? (*dàizi.*) Luggage? (*xíngli.*) Takeaway? (*wàimài.*) To make a booking? (*dìng.*) Address? (*dìzhǐ.*) To pack food to take away? (打包, *dǎbāo.*) Dim sum? (点心, *diǎnxin.*) To teach? (*jiāo.*) To practise? (*liànxí.*) To answer? (*huídá.*) To revise? (*fùxí.*) Wrong? (*cuò.*) To be open for business? (*yíngyè.*) To begin? (*kāishǐ.*) To come to an end? (*jiéshù.*) Timetable? (*shíkèbiǎo.*) To give a discount? (*dǎzhé.*)

122.7 Opening Hours — once more

Say the Mandarin for to be open for business and to begin.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to be open for business, to begin, to come to an end, timetable, to give a discount

Before you move on

To be open for business? (*yíngyè.*) To begin? (*kāishǐ.*) To come to an end? (*jiéshù.*) Timetable? (*shíkèbiǎo.*) To give a discount? (*dǎzhé.*)

Chapter 123

What People Are Like

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that someone is clever, serious, lovable, warm or caring.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 123: I can say that someone is clever, serious, lovable, warm or caring.*

123.1 cōngming — clever; bright

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for timetable, then the Mandarin for to give a discount.

You'll want to know: cōngming

cōngming — "clever; bright".

> *wǒ mèimei hěn cōngming* — My little sister is very bright.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cōngming is built from *cōng* and *míng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshuwng* and *mjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to hear' and 'to discern', and the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: cōngming*
- *Say it: cōngming*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mèimei hěn cōngming* — My little sister is very bright.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for timetable, then the Mandarin for to give a discount, then say *cōngming* again

Before you move on

What does cōngming mean? ("Clever; bright".) Say it once more.

123.2 rènzhēn — conscientious; serious

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give a discount, then the Mandarin for clever.

You'll want to know: rènzhēn

rènzhēn — "conscientious; serious".

tā gōngzuò hěn rènzhēn — He takes his work seriously.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rènzhēn is built from *rèn* 'to recognise' and *zhēn* 'true', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyinH* and *tsyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How the pair came to mean conscientious is not given there, so it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: rènzhēn*
- *Say it: rènzhēn*, once more
- *Say it: tā gōngzuò hěn rènzhēn* — He takes his work seriously.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give a discount, then the Mandarin for clever, then say *rènzhēn* again

Before you move on

What does rènzhēn mean? ("Conscientious; serious".) Say it once more.

123.3 kě'ài — cute; lovable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for clever, then the Mandarin for conscientious.

You'll want to know: kě'ài

kě'ài — "cute; lovable".

zhè zhī māo hěn kě'ài — This cat is so cute.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kě'ài is built from *kě*, glossed 'to permit', and *ài* 'to love', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *'ojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): worth loving.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: kě'ài*
- *Say it: kě'ài*, once more
- *Say it: zhè zhī māo hěn kě'ài* — This cat is so cute.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for clever, then the Mandarin for conscientious, then say *kě'ài* again

Before you move on

What does kě'ài mean? ("Cute; lovable".) Say it once more.

123.4 rèqíng — warm; welcoming

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for conscientious, then the Mandarin for lovable.

You'll want to know: rèqíng

rèqíng — "warm; welcoming".

wǒ de lǎoshī hěn rèqíng — My teacher is very warm.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rèqíng is built from *rè* 'hot' and *qíng* 'feeling', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyet* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary explains the second, after an older book, as the breath in a person that has desires.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: rèqíng*
- *Say it: rèqíng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de lǎoshī hěn rèqíng* — My teacher is very warm.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for conscientious, then the Mandarin for lovable, then say *rèqíng* again

Before you move on

What does rèqíng mean? ("Warm; welcoming".) Say it once more.

123.5 guānxīn — to care about

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lovable, then the Mandarin for warm-hearted.

You'll want to know: guānxīn

guānxīn — "to care about".

māma hěn guānxīn wǒ — Mum really cares about me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guānxīn is built from *guān*, the word for shutting, and *xīn* 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaen* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the bar that shuts a door; how the pair came to mean caring is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānxīn*
- *Say it: guānxīn*, once more
- *Say it: māma hěn guānxīn wǒ* — Mum really cares about me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lovable, then the Mandarin for warm-hearted, then say *guānxīn* again

Before you move on

What does guānxīn mean? ("To care about".) Say it once more.

Chapter 124

Tall and Handsome

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can talk about height, hair, good and bad looks, and family likeness.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 124: I can talk about height, hair, good and bad looks, and family likeness.

124.1 个子 (gèzi) — height; build (of a person)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for warm-hearted, then the Mandarin for to care about.

You'll want to know: 个子

个子 — *gèzi* — "height; build (of a person)".

wǒ gēge gèzi hěn gāo — My brother is tall.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

个子 (*gèzi*) is built from 个, the measure word, and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How the pair came to mean a person's height is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: gèzi*
- *Say it: gèzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēge gèzi hěn gāo* — My brother is tall.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for warm-hearted, then the Mandarin for to care about, then say *gèzi* again

Before you move on

What does 个子 mean? ("Height; build (of a person)".) Say it once more.

124.2 tóufa — hair (on the head)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to care about, then the Mandarin for a person's height.

You'll want to know: tóufa

tóufa — "hair (on the head)".

tā de tóufa hěn cháng — Her hair is long.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóufa is built from *tóu* 'head' and *fa*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duw* and *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the hair of the head'. In the word it loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóufa*
- *Say it: tóufa*, once more
- *Say it: tā de tóufa hěn cháng* — Her hair is long.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to care about, then the Mandarin for a person's height, then say *tóufa* again

Before you move on

What does tóufa mean? ("Hair (on the head)".) Say it once more.

124.3 shuài — handsome

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a person's height, then the Mandarin for hair.

You'll want to know: shuài

shuài — "handsome".

nǐ gēge hěn shuài — Your brother is handsome.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuài is inherited from Middle Chinese *srwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a commander of troops'. The sense handsome is not given there, and how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuài*
- *Say it: shuài*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ gēge hěn shuài* — Your brother is handsome.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a person's height, then the Mandarin for hair, then say *shuài* again

Before you move on

What does shuài mean? ("Handsome".) Say it once more.

124.4 nánkàn — ugly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hair, then the Mandarin for handsome.

You'll want to know: nánkàn

nánkàn — "ugly".

wǒ de xié hěn nánkàn — My shoes are ugly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nánkàn is built from *nán* 'hard' and 看 'to look at', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan* and *khanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): hard to look at.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánkàn*
- *Say it: nánkàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de xié hěn nánkàn* — My shoes are ugly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hair, then the Mandarin for handsome, then say *nánkàn* again

Before you move on

What does nánkàn mean? ("Ugly".) Say it once more.

124.5 xiàng — to resemble; to take after

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for handsome, then the Mandarin for ugly.

You'll want to know: xiàng

xiàng — "to resemble; to take after".

wǒ xiàng wǒ bàba — I take after my dad.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàng is inherited from Middle Chinese *zjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to be like'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàng*
- *Say it: xiàng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiàng wǒ bàba* — I take after my dad.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for handsome, then the Mandarin for ugly, then say *xiàng* again

Before you move on

What does xiàng mean? ("To resemble; to take after".) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Angry and Worried

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give a feeling as a reason: angry, worried, at ease, anxious or upset.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 125: I can give a feeling as a reason: angry, worried, at ease, anxious or upset.*

125.1 生气 (shēngqì) — to get angry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ugly, then the Mandarin for to resemble.

You'll want to know: 生气

生气 — *shēngqì* — "to get angry".

> 因为我没有来他生气了 *yīnwèi wǒ méiyǒu lái tā shēngqì le* — He got angry because I didn't come.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生气 (*shēngqì*) is built from 生 'to grow' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The sense angry is not given there, so how the pair came to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngqì*
- *Say it: shēngqì*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi wǒ méiyǒu lái tā shēngqì le* — He got angry because I didn't come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ugly, then the Mandarin for to resemble, then say *shēngqì* again

Before you move on

What does 生气 mean? ("To get angry".) Say it once more.

125.2 dānxīn — to worry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to resemble, then the Mandarin for to get angry.

You'll want to know: dānxīn

dānxīn — "to worry".

nǐ bú yào dānxīn — Don't you worry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dānxīn is built from *dān* 'to carry on the shoulder' and *xīn* 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tam* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The pair is not given there; a load carried in the heart is the plain picture, but the step is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dānxīn*
- *Say it: dānxīn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bú yào dānxīn* — Don't you worry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to resemble, then the Mandarin for to get angry, then say *dānxīn* again

Before you move on

What does dānxīn mean? ("To worry".) Say it once more.

125.3 fàngxīn — to stop worrying; to be at ease

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get angry, then the Mandarin for to worry.

You'll want to know: fàngxīn

fàngxīn — "to stop worrying; to be at ease".

nǐ fàngxīn wǒ hěn hǎo — Don't worry, I'm fine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàngxīn is built from *fàng*, the word for putting things down, and *xīn* 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjangH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to drive out' and 'to send away'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàngxīn*
- *Say it: fàngxīn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ fàngxīn wǒ hěn hǎo* — Don't worry, I'm fine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get angry, then the Mandarin for to worry, then say *fàngxīn* again

Before you move on

What does fàngxīn mean? ("To stop worrying; to be at ease".) Say it once more.

125.4 zháojí — anxious; in a hurry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to worry, then the Mandarin for to be at ease.

You'll want to know: zháojí

zháojí — "anxious; in a hurry".

wǒ hěn zháojí yīnwèi wǒ yǒushì — I'm in a rush, because I've got something on.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zháojí is built from *zháo* and *jí*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjak* and *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to attach to' and the second 'urgent' and 'narrow'; how the pair came to mean anxious is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zháojí*
- *Say it: zháojí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn zháojí yīnwèi wǒ yǒushì* — I'm in a rush, because I've got something on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to worry, then the Mandarin for to be at ease, then say *zháojí* again

Before you move on

What does zháojí mean? ("Anxious; in a hurry".) Say it once more.

125.5 nánguò — sad; upset

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be at ease, then the Mandarin for anxious.

You'll want to know: nánguò

nánguò — "sad; upset".

tā de gǒu bìng le tā hěn nánguò — His dog is ill, and he's very upset.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nánguò is built from *nán* 'hard' and *guò* 'to pass', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan* and *kwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): hard to get through. The pair is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánguò*
- *Say it: nánguò*, once more
- *Say it: tā de gǒu bìng le tā hěn nánguò* — His dog is ill, and he's very upset.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be at ease, then the Mandarin for anxious, then say *nánguò* again

Before you move on

What does nánguò mean? ("Sad; upset".) Say it once more.

Chapter 126

Often and Sometimes

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how often I do things, what I did before and what I did a moment ago.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 126: I can say how often I do things, what I did before and what I did a moment ago.*

126.1 chángcháng — often

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for anxious, then the Mandarin for upset.

You'll want to know: chángcháng

chángcháng — "often".

> *wǒ chángcháng hē chá* — I often drink tea.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chángcháng says *cháng* twice. It is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it as a length of two fathoms and as an official title. The sense 'usual' is not given there, so how it came to mean often is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: chángcháng*
- *Say it: chángcháng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chángcháng hē chá* — I often drink tea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for anxious, then the Mandarin for upset, then say *chángcháng* again

Before you move on

What does chángcháng mean? ("Often".) Say it once more.

126.2 yǒushíhou — sometimes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for upset, then the Mandarin for often.

You'll want to know: yǒushíhou

yǒushíhou — "sometimes".

wǒ yǒushíhou qù Běijīng — Sometimes I go to Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒushíhou is built from 有 'there is' and *shíhou* 'time', all three parts inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX*, *dzyi* and *huwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): there are times.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒushíhou*
- *Say it: yǒushíhou*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒushíhou qù Běijīng* — Sometimes I go to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for upset, then the Mandarin for often, then say *yǒushíhou* again

Before you move on

What does yǒushíhou mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

126.3 以前 (yǐqián) — before; in the past

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for often, then the Mandarin for sometimes.

You’ll want to know: 以前

以前 — *yǐqián* — “before; in the past”.

以前我不会说汉语 *yǐqián wǒ bú huì shuō hànyǔ* — I couldn’t speak Chinese before.

The new character, in pieces: 以 — four strokes: a vertical that flicks up at its foot, a dot beside it, then a long stroke falling to the left and a dot at the lower right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

以前 (*yǐqián*) is built from 以, glossed ’to use’ and ’with’, and 前 ’before’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yiX* and *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription).

What you’ve built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐqián*
- *Say it: yǐqián*, once more
- *Say it: yǐqián wǒ bú huì shuō hànyǔ* — I couldn't speak Chinese before.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for often, then the Mandarin for sometimes, then say *yǐqián* again

Before you move on

What does 以前 mean? ("Before; in the past".) Say it once more.

126.4 以 — four strokes in two pairs

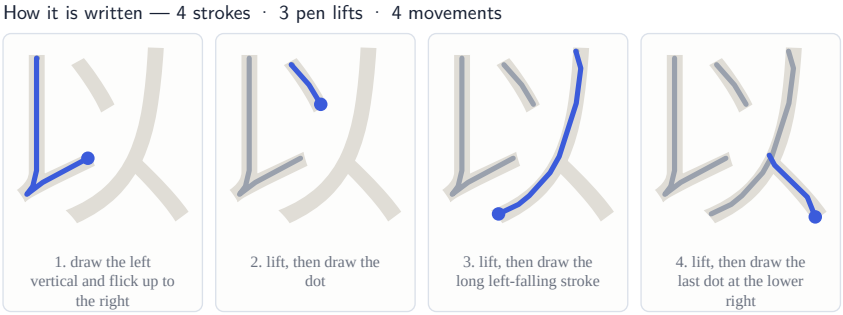
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yǐqián* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  前 会

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qián*, *huì*

Script — four strokes in two pairs



How 以 is written, stroke by stroke

以

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, two strokes. A vertical that runs down and flicks up to the right at its foot, then a short dot to the right of it, falling to the lower right.

The right piece, two strokes. A long left-falling stroke from the top right, sweeping down toward the foot of the first stroke, then a dot at the lower right, falling to the lower right.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 以, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 以? (**Four**.) Which stroke flicks up? (**The first, at its foot**.) Which way does the long one fall? (**Down to the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 以, pinned stroke paths and medians.

126.5 gāngcái — a moment ago

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sometimes, then the Mandarin for in the past.

You'll want to know: gāngcái

gāngcái — "a moment ago".

gāngcái wǒ zài xǐshǒujiān — A moment ago I was in the toilet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gāngcái is built from *gāng* and *cái*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kang* and *dzoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'strong', and lists the second, under an older way of writing it, as 'barely', a different word from the *cái* of talent; how the pair came to mean a moment ago is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāngcái*
- *Say it: gāngcái*, once more
- *Say it: gāngcái wǒ zài xǐshǒujiān* — A moment ago I was in the toilet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sometimes, then the Mandarin for in the past, then say *gāngcái* again

Before you move on

What does gāngcái mean? ("A moment ago".) Say it once more.

126.6 yǐjīng — already

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in the past, then the Mandarin for a moment ago.

You'll want to know: yǐjīng

yǐjīng — "already".

wǒ yǐjīng chī fàn le — I've already eaten.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǐjīng is built from *yǐ* and *jīng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yiX* and *keng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to stop' and 'finished', a different word from the 以 of 以前, and the second 'constant' and 'the warp of cloth'; how the pair came to mean already is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐjīng*
- *Say it: yǐjīng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǐjīng chī fàn le* — I've already eaten.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in the past, then the Mandarin for a moment ago, then say *yǐjīng* again

Before you move on

What does yǐjīng mean? ("Already".) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

These and Those

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say these, those, which ones, some, and like this.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 127: I can say these, those, which ones, some, and like this.*

127.1 这些 (zhèxiē) — these

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a moment ago, then the Mandarin for already.

You'll want to know: 这些

这些 — *zhèxiē* — "these".

> 这些是我以前的书 *zhèxiē shì wǒ yǐqián de shū* — These are my old books.

The new character, in pieces: 些 — on top a four-stroke piece and a two-stroke piece side by side, and under them the two bars of 二. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

这些 (*zhèxiē*) is built from 这 'this' and 些 'a few'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), glossed 'a little'.

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèxiē*
- *Say it: zhèxiē*, once more
- *Say it: zhèxiē shì wǒ yǐqián de shū* — These are my old books.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a moment ago, then the Mandarin for already, then say *zhèxiē* again

Before you move on

What does 这些 mean? ("These".) Say it once more.

127.2 些 — two small pieces over 二

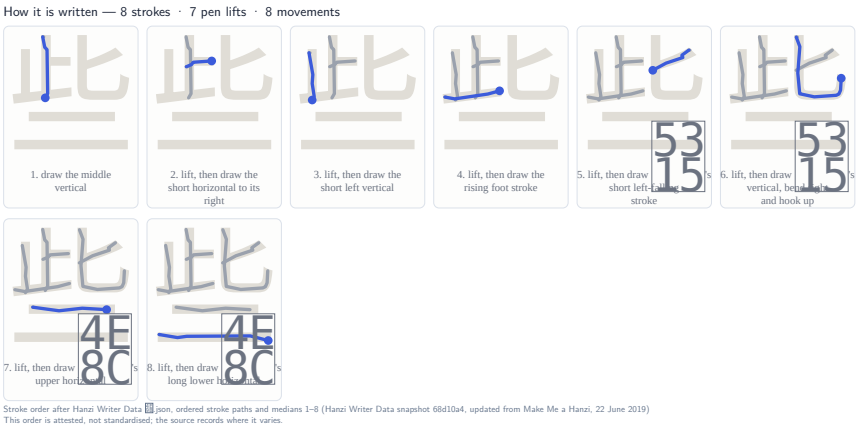
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhèxiē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  这 二

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhè*, *èr*

Script — two small pieces over 二



How 些 is written, stroke by stroke

些

Three pieces: two side by side on top, then 二 underneath.

The top left piece, four strokes. A short vertical, a short horizontal from its middle to the right, a shorter vertical to the left of the first, then a stroke along the foot that rises to the right.

The top right piece, two strokes. A short left-falling stroke, then a vertical that bends to the right along the bottom and hooks up.

二, two strokes: the short bar, then the long one beneath it.

4 + 2 + 2 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 些, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 些? (**Three**.) Which character you know sits at the bottom? (二.) How does the sixth stroke end? (**It bends right along the bottom and hooks up**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 些, pinned stroke paths and medians.

127.3 那些 (nàxiē) — those

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for already, then the Mandarin for these.

You'll want to know: 那些

那些 — *nàxiē* — "those".

那些人是我以前的同学 *nàxiē rén shì wǒ yǐqián de tóngxué* — Those people are my old classmates.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

那些 (*nàxiē*) is built from 那 'that' and 些 'a few', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *na* and *sjae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'how, what', not 'that', and the second 'a little'.

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: nàxiē*
- *Say it: nàxiē*, once more
- *Say it: nàxiē rén shì wǒ yǐqián de tóngxué* — Those people are my old classmates.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for already, then the Mandarin for these, then say *nàxiē* again

Before you move on

What does 那些 mean? ("Those".) Say it once more.

127.4 哪些 (nǎxiē) — which ones

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for these, then the Mandarin for those.

You'll want to know: 哪些

哪些 — *nǎxiē* — "which ones".

你喜欢哪些书 *nǐ xǐhuan nǎxiē shū* — Which books do you like?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

哪些 (*nǎxiē*) is built from 哪 'which' and 些 'a few'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǎxiē*
- *Say it: nǎxiē*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐhuan nǎxiē shū* — Which books do you like?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for these, then the Mandarin for those, then say *nǎxiē* again

Before you move on

What does 哪些 mean? ("Which ones".) Say it once more.

127.5 一些 (yìxiē) — some; a few

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for those, then the Mandarin for which ones.

You'll want to know: 一些

一些 — *yìxiē* — "some; a few".

我想喝一些水 *wǒ xiǎng hē yìxiē shuǐ* — I'd like to drink some water.

The tone of 一 changes here: yī is said yì before the first tone of xiē.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一些 (*yìxiē*) is built from 一 'one' and 些 'a few', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *sjae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìxiē*
- *Say it: yìxiē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng hē yìxiē shuǐ* — I'd like to drink some water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for those, then the Mandarin for which ones, then say *yìxiē* again

Before you move on

What does 一些 mean? ("Some; a few".) Say it once more.

127.6 zhèyàng — like this; this way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for which ones, then the Mandarin for a few.

You'll want to know: zhèyàng

zhèyàng — "like this; this way".

nǐ kěyǐ zhèyàng zuò — You can do it this way.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhèyàng is built from 这 'this' and *yàng* 'a pattern', the *yàng* of *yíyàng*. No dictionary we use records an older form of either part in these

senses, so the history of the pair is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèyàng*
- *Say it: zhèyàng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ kěyǐ zhèyàng zuò* — You can do it this way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for which ones, then the Mandarin for a few, then say *zhèyàng* again

Before you move on

What does zhèyàng mean? ("Like this; this way".) Say it once more.

Chapter 128

Music

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about music: songs, the piano and the guitar, and what sounds good.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can talk about music: songs, the piano and the guitar, and what sounds good.*

128.1 音乐 (yīnyuè) — music

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a few, then the Mandarin for like this.

You'll want to know: 音乐

音乐 — *yīnyuè* — "music".

> 我喜欢音乐 *wǒ xǐhuan yīnyuè* — I love music.

The new character, in pieces: 音 — on top a five-stroke piece — a dot, a short bar, two short strokes leaning toward each other, and a long bar — and under it 日. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

音乐 (*yīnyuè*) is built from 音 'sound' and 乐, here said *yuè*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'im* and *ngaewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second with the

whole word, 'music'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīnyuè*
- *Say it: yīnyuè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan yīnyuè* — I love music.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a few, then the Mandarin for like this, then say *yīnyuè* again

Before you move on

What does 音乐 mean? ("Music".) Say it once more.

128.2 音 — five strokes over 日

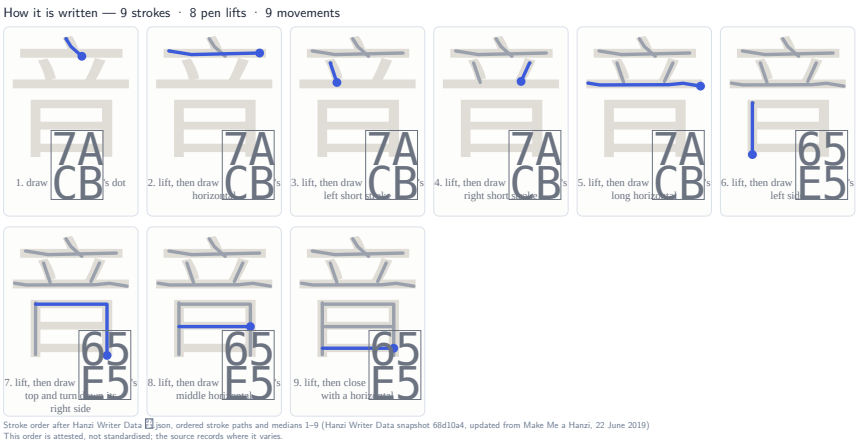
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yīnyuè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 乐

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *lè*

Script — five strokes over 日



How 音 *is written, stroke by stroke*

音

Two pieces, top to bottom.

The top piece, five strokes. A dot at the top, a short horizontal under it, a short stroke on the left falling to the lower right, a short stroke on the right falling to the lower left, then a long horizontal across the whole width.

日, four strokes, the four your hand makes in 日: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, and the bar that closes the bottom.

5 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 音, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 音? (**Two**.) Which stroke ends the top piece? (**The long horizontal**.) What sits underneath? (日.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 音, pinned stroke paths and medians.

128.3 gē — song

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for like this, then the Mandarin for music.

You'll want to know: gē

gē — "song".

wǒ xǐhuan Zhōngguó gē — I love Chinese songs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gē is inherited from Middle Chinese *ka* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary quotes an older book: the voice of a person is called song.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: gē*
- *Say it: gē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan Zhōngguó gē* — I love Chinese songs.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for like this, then the Mandarin for music, then say *gē* again

Before you move on

What does gē mean? ("Song".) Say it once more.

128.4 hǎotīng — pleasant to hear

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for music, then the Mandarin for song.

You'll want to know: hǎotīng

hǎotīng — "pleasant to hear".

Zhōngguó yīnyuè hěn hǎotīng — Chinese music is lovely to listen to.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎotīng is built from 好 'good' and *tīng* 'to listen', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *theng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), the same shape as 好看 and 好吃.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎotīng*
- *Say it: hǎotīng*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngguó yīnyuè hěn hǎotīng* — Chinese music is lovely to listen to.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for music, then the Mandarin for song, then say *hǎotīng* again

Before you move on

What does hǎotīng mean? ("Pleasant to hear".) Say it once more.

128.5 音乐会 (yīnyuèhuì) — concert

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for song, then the Mandarin for pleasant to hear.

You'll want to know: 音乐会

音乐会 — *yīnyuèhuì* — "concert".

> 明天晚上我们去音乐会 *míngtiān wǎnshang wǒmen qù yīnyuèhuì* — Tomorrow evening we're going to a concert.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

音乐会 (*yīnyuèhuì*) is built from 音乐 'music' and 会 'a gathering', all three parts inherited from Middle Chinese, *'im*, *ngaewk* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the last 'to come together'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīnyuèhuì*
- *Say it: yīnyuèhuì*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǎnshang wǒmen qù yīnyuèhuì* — Tomorrow evening we're going to a concert.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for song, then the Mandarin for pleasant to hear, then say *yīnyuèhuì* again

Before you move on

What does 音乐会 mean? ("Concert".) Say it once more.

128.6 jítā — guitar

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pleasant to hear, then the Mandarin for concert.

You'll want to know: jítā

jítā — "guitar".

wǒ xiǎng xué jítā — I'd like to learn the guitar.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jítā is usually traced to English *guitar*; its two characters were chosen for their sound, the first a word for lucky and the second the 他 of 'he'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: jítā*
- *Say it: jítā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng xué jítā* — I'd like to learn the guitar.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pleasant to hear, then the Mandarin for concert, then say *jítā* again

Before you move on

What does jítā mean? ("Guitar".) Say it once more.

128.7 Looking back: from What People Are Like to Music

Say the Mandarin for clever and conscientious.

Your turn

- *Say it:* clever, conscientious, lovable, warm-hearted, to care about
- *Say it:* a person's height, hair, handsome, ugly, to resemble

- *Say it:* to get angry, to worry, to be at ease, anxious, upset
- *Say it:* often, sometimes, in the past, a moment ago, already
- *Say it:* these, those, which ones, a few, like this
- *Say it:* music, song, pleasant to hear, concert, guitar
- *Read it:* 以 些 音 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Clever? (*cōngming.*) Conscientious? (*rènzhēn.*) Lovable? (*kě'ài.*) Warm-hearted? (*rèqíng.*) To care about? (*guānxīn.*) A person's height? (个子, *gèzi.*) Hair? (*tóufa.*) Handsome? (*shuài.*) Ugly? (*nánkàn.*) To resemble? (*xiàng.*) To get angry? (生气, *shēngqì.*) To worry? (*dānxīn.*) To be at ease? (*fàngxīn.*) Anxious? (*zháojí.*) Upset? (*nánguò.*) Often? (*chángcháng.*) Sometimes? (*yǒushíhou.*) In the past? (以前, *yǐqián.*) A moment ago? (*gāngcái.*) Already? (*yǐjīng.*) These? (这些, *zhèxiē.*) Those? (那些, *nàxiē.*) Which ones? (哪些, *nǎxiē.*) A few? (一些, *yìxiē.*) Like this? (*zhèyàng.*) Music? (音乐, *yīnyuè.*) Song? (*gē.*) Pleasant to hear? (*hǎotīng.*) Concert? (音乐会, *yīnyuèhuì.*) Guitar? (*jítā.*)

Chapter 129

Quiet and Noisy

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a place is quiet, noisy, lively or handy, and that something is interesting.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can say a place is quiet, noisy, lively or handy, and that something is interesting.*

129.1 ānjìng — quiet

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for concert, then the Mandarin for guitar.

You'll want to know: ānjìng

ānjìng — "quiet".

> *wǒ de fángjiān hěn ānjìng* — My room is quiet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ānjìng is built from *ān* 'peaceful' and *jìng* 'calm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an* and *dzjengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second with the first.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānjìng*
- *Say it: ānjìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de fángjiān hěn ānjìng* — My room is quiet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for concert, then the Mandarin for guitar, then say *ānjìng* again

Before you move on

What does ānjìng mean? ("Quiet".) Say it once more.

129.2 吵 (chǎo) — noisy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for guitar, then the Mandarin for quiet.

You'll want to know: 吵

吵 — *chǎo* — "noisy".

他的音乐太吵了 *tā de yīnyuè tài chǎo le* — His music is far too loud.

The new character, in pieces: 吵 — 口 on the left and 少 on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

吵 (*chǎo*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsrhaewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'sound', a different word from the *chǎo* of stir-frying, which has the same old form. The dictionary notes that the character first had another reading, *mjiewX*, glossed 'the call of a pheasant'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǎo*
- *Say it: chǎo*, once more
- *Say it: tā de yīnyuè tài chǎo le* — His music is far too loud.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for guitar, then the Mandarin for quiet, then say *chǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 吵 mean? ("Noisy".) Say it once more.

129.3 吵 — 口, then 少

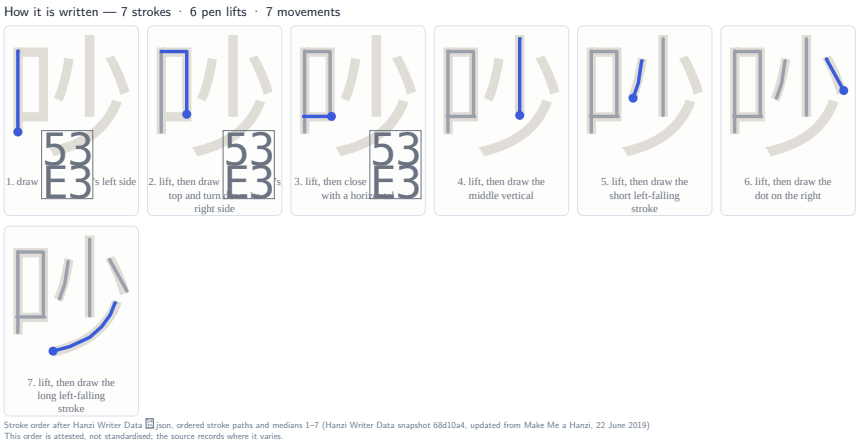
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chǎo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

口 少

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *shǎo*

Script — 口, then 少



How 吵 is written, stroke by stroke

吵

Two pieces, left before right, and both are old friends.

口**, three strokes**, small and narrow on the left: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, and the bar that closes the bottom.

少**, four strokes**, on the right: the vertical down the middle, the short stroke on its left, the dot on its right, then the long left-falling stroke that sweeps under them.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 吵, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

What are the two pieces of 吵? (口 **and** 少.) Which side is narrow? (**The left,** 口.) What does the last stroke do? (**It sweeps down to the left under** 少.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 吵, pinned stroke paths and medians.

129.4 rènao — lively; bustling

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for quiet, then the Mandarin for noisy.

You'll want to know: rènao

rènao — "lively; bustling".

Běijīng hěn rènao — Beijing is a lively place.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rènao is built from *rè* 'hot' and *nao*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyet* and *nraewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'not quiet' and 'to stir up'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: rènao*
- *Say it: rènao*, once more
- *Say it: Běijīng hěn rènao* — Beijing is a lively place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for quiet, then the Mandarin for noisy, then say *rènao* again

Before you move on

What does rènao mean? ("Lively; bustling".) Say it once more.

129.5 fāngbiàn — convenient; handy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for noisy, then the Mandarin for bustling.

You'll want to know: fāngbiàn

fāngbiàn — "convenient; handy".

> *zhèr mǎi dōngxi hěn fāngbiàn* — Shopping here is easy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāngbiàn is built from *fāng* and *biàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjang* and *bjienH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'the four quarters' and 'a method', and the second 'advantageous'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāngbiàn*
- *Say it: fāngbiàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr mǎi dōngxi hěn fāngbiàn* — Shopping here is easy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for noisy, then the Mandarin for bustling, then say *fāngbiàn* again

Before you move on

What does fāngbiàn mean? ("Convenient; handy".) Say it once more.

129.6 yǒuyìsi — interesting

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bustling, then the Mandarin for convenient.

You'll want to know: yǒuyìsi

yǒuyìsi — "interesting".

> *xué hànyǔ hěn yǒuyìsi* — Learning Chinese is interesting.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒuyìsi is built from 有 'to have' and *yìsi* 'meaning', the *yìsi* of *bù hǎoyìsi*: to have meaning. The parts are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX*, *'iH* and *si* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒuyìsi*
- *Say it: yǒuyìsi*, once more
- *Say it: xué hànyǔ hěn yǒuyìsi* — Learning Chinese is interesting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bustling, then the Mandarin for convenient, then say *yǒuyìsi* again

Before you move on

What does yǒuyìsi mean? ("Interesting".) Say it once more.

Chapter 130

Feeling Ill

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am ill, have a cold or a fever, or that something hurts, and go to the doctor.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can say I am ill, have a cold or a fever, or that something hurts, and go to the doctor.*

130.1 病人 (bìngrén) — patient; sick person

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for convenient, then the Mandarin for interesting.

You'll want to know: 病人

病人 — *bìngrén* — "patient; sick person".

> 病人想喝水 *bìngrén xiǎng hē shuǐ* — The patient would like some water.

The new character, in pieces: 病 — outside, the sickbed piece of five strokes: a dot, a bar, a long fall down the left, then a dot and a rising stroke on the left side; inside it, five strokes: a bar, a box with a hooked right side, and a small 人 in the box. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

病人 (*bìngrén*) is built from 病 'illness' and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaengH* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'grief' and 'suffering', and quotes an older book: an illness grown worse.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìngrén*
- *Say it: bìngrén*, once more
- *Say it: bìngrén xiǎng hē shuǐ* — The patient would like some water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for convenient, then the Mandarin for interesting, then say *bìngrén* again

Before you move on

What does 病人 mean? ("Patient; sick person".) Say it once more.

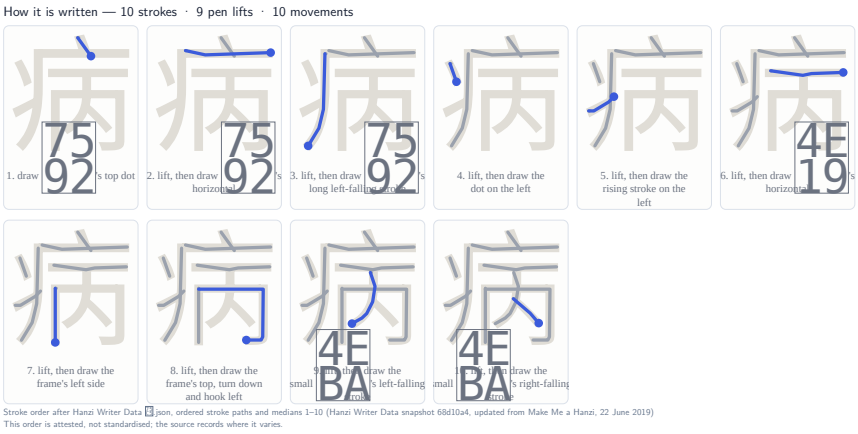
130.2 病 — the sickbed piece around a box

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bìngrén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

人 男

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *nán*

Script — the sickbed piece around a box

How 病 *is written, stroke by stroke*

病

Two pieces: the sickbed piece outside, a boxed piece inside.

The sickbed piece, five strokes. A dot at the top, a horizontal under it, a long left-falling stroke down the left side, then on the left a short dot and a short stroke rising to the right.

The inside piece, five strokes. A horizontal across the top; a short vertical, the left side of the box; a horizontal that turns down the right side and hooks; then a small 人 from the top bar into the box: its left-falling stroke, then its dot.

5 + 5 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 病, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 病? (**Two** — the sickbed piece and the boxed piece.) What sits on the left of the sickbed piece? (**A dot and a**

rising stroke.) What is inside the box? (**A small 人**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 病, pinned stroke paths and medians.

130.3 gǎnmào — to catch a cold; a cold

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for interesting, then the Mandarin for a sick person.

You'll want to know: gǎnmào

gǎnmào — "to catch a cold; a cold".

wǒ gǎnmào le — I've caught a cold.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎnmào is built from *gǎn* and *mào*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *mawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to move' and the second 'to cover' and 'to wade'; how the pair came to mean a cold is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnmào*
- *Say it: gǎnmào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnmào le* — I've caught a cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for interesting, then the Mandarin for a sick person, then say *gǎnmào* again

Before you move on

What does gǎnmào mean? ("To catch a cold; a cold".) Say it once more.

130.4 fāshāo — to have a fever

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sick person, then the Mandarin for to catch a cold.

You'll want to know: fāshāo

fāshāo — "to have a fever".

wǒ fāshāo le wǒ xiǎng shuìjiào — I've got a temperature and I want to sleep.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāshāo is built from *fā* 'to start' and *shāo* 'to burn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *syew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāshāo*
- *Say it: fāshāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ fāshāo le wǒ xiǎng shuìjiào* — I've got a temperature and I want to sleep.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sick person, then the Mandarin for to catch a cold, then say *fāshāo* again

Before you move on

What does fāshāo mean? ("To have a fever".) Say it once more.

130.5 téng — sore; painful

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to catch a cold, then the Mandarin for to have a fever.

You'll want to know: téng

téng — "sore; painful".

wǒ de tóu hěn téng — My head really hurts.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

téng is inherited from Middle Chinese *downg* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'pain'. The regular sound change would give *tóng*, not *téng*; why the vowel differs is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: téng*
- *Say it: téng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de tóu hěn téng* — My head really hurts.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to catch a cold, then the Mandarin for to have a fever, then say *téng* again

Before you move on

What does téng mean? ("Sore; painful".) Say it once more.

130.6 看病 (kànbìng) — to see a doctor

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a fever, then the Mandarin for sore.

You'll want to know: 看病

看病 — *kànbìng* — "to see a doctor".

我病了我去看病 *wǒ bìng le wǒ qù kànbìng* — I'm ill, so I'm off to the doctor.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

看病 (*kànbìng*) is built from 看 'to look at' and 病 'illness', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khanH* and *bjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to have an illness looked at.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kànbìng*
- *Say it: kànbìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bìng le wǒ qù kànbìng* — I'm ill, so I'm off to the doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a fever, then the Mandarin for sore, then say *kànbìng* again

Before you move on

What does 看病 mean? ("To see a doctor".) Say it once more.

Chapter 131

Four Seasons

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the four seasons and ask which one someone likes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can name the four seasons and ask which one someone likes.*

131.1 春天 (chūntiān) — spring

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sore, then the Mandarin for to see a doctor.

You'll want to know: 春天

春天 — *chūntiān* — "spring".

> 我喜欢春天 *wǒ xǐhuan chūntiān* — I love spring.

The new character, in pieces: 春 — the three bars of 三, a 人 whose two strokes spread across them, and 日 underneath. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

春天 (*chūntiān*) is built from 春 'spring' and 天 'sky, day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwin* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'the head of the four seasons'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūntiān*
- *Say it: chūntiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan chūntiān* — I love spring.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sore, then the Mandarin for to see a doctor, then say *chūntiān* again

Before you move on

What does 春天 mean? ("Spring".) Say it once more.

131.2 春 — 三 and 人 over 日

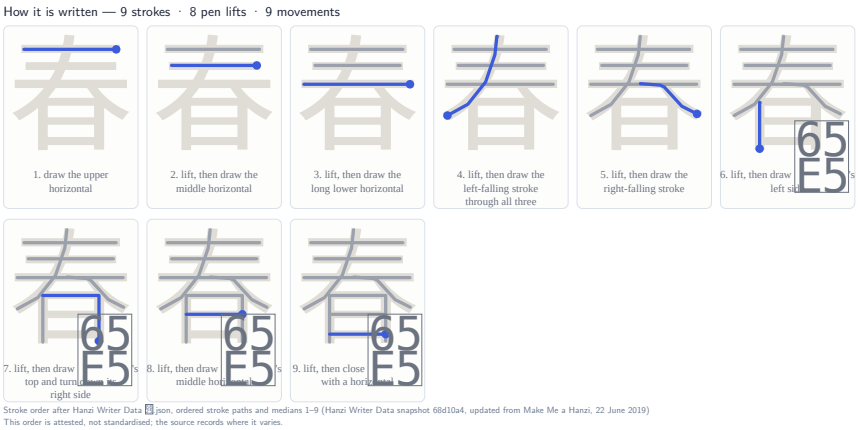
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chūntiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

三 人 日

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *sān*, *rén*, *rì*

Script — 三 and 人 over 日



How 春 is written, stroke by stroke

春

Three pieces you know, top to bottom, the first two woven together.

The three bars of 三: two shorter bars, then a long third one.

人, two strokes, spread wide across the bars: the left-falling stroke from above the top bar down to the lower left, then the right-falling stroke from the middle out to the lower right.

日, four strokes, small, under the spread of 人.

3 + 2 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 春, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 春? (**Nine.**) Which bar is the longest? (**The third.**) What sits at the bottom? (日.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 春, pinned stroke paths and medians.

131.3 xiàtiān — summer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to see a doctor, then the Mandarin for spring.

You'll want to know: xiàtiān

xiàtiān — "summer".

Běijīng de xiàtiān hěn rè — Summers in Beijing are hot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàtiān is built from *xià* 'summer' and 天 'sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeH* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the first under the words 'spring and summer'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàtiān*
- *Say it: xiàtiān*, once more
- *Say it: Běijīng de xiàtiān hěn rè* — Summers in Beijing are hot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to see a doctor, then the Mandarin for spring, then say *xiàtiān* again

Before you move on

What does xiàtiān mean? ("Summer".) Say it once more.

131.4 qiūtiān — autumn

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for spring, then the Mandarin for summer.

You'll want to know: qiūtiān

qiūtiān — "autumn".

> *qiūtiān bù lěng yě bú rè* — Autumn is neither cold nor hot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiūtiān is built from *qiū* 'autumn' and 天 'sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjuw* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary quotes an older book for the first: the time when grain is ripe.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiūtiān*
- *Say it: qiūtiān*, once more
- *Say it: qiūtiān bù lěng yě bú rè* — Autumn is neither cold nor hot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for spring, then the Mandarin for summer, then say *qiūtiān* again

Before you move on

What does qiūtiān mean? ("Autumn".) Say it once more.

131.5 dōngtiān — winter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for summer, then the Mandarin for autumn.

You'll want to know: dōngtiān

dōngtiān — "winter".

> *dōngtiān wǒ bù xiǎng chūmén* — In winter I don't feel like going out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dōngtiān is built from *dōng* 'winter' and 天 'sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *towng* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'the last of the four seasons'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōngtiān*
- *Say it: dōngtiān*, once more
- *Say it: dōngtiān wǒ bù xiǎng chūmén* — In winter I don't feel like going out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for summer, then the Mandarin for autumn, then say *dōngtiān* again

Before you move on

What does dōngtiān mean? ("Winter".) Say it once more.

131.6 jìjié — season

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for autumn, then the Mandarin for winter.

You'll want to know: jìjié

jìjié — "season".

nǐ xǐhuan nǎge jìjié — Which season do you like?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìjié is built from *jì* and *jié*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjwijH* and *tset* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'the youngest of brothers' and the second, after an older book, 'the joint of a bamboo'; how the pair came to mean a season is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìjié*
- *Say it: jìjié*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐhuan nǎge jìjié* — Which season do you like?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for autumn, then the Mandarin for winter, then say *jìjié* again

Before you move on

What does jìjié mean? ("Season".) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

Thousands

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count in thousands and ten thousands, say zero, and say how many in all.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can count in thousands and ten thousands, say zero, and say how many in all.*

132.1 千 (qiān) — thousand

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for winter, then the Mandarin for season.

You'll want to know: 千

千 — *qiān* — "thousand".

> 我们大学有三千个学生 *wǒmen dàxué yǒu sānqiān ge xuésheng* — Our university has three thousand students.

The new character, in pieces: 千 — a short fall over 十. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

千 (*qiān*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'ten hundreds'.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiān*
- *Say it: qiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen dàxué yǒu sānqiān ge xuésheng* — Our university has three thousand students.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for winter, then the Mandarin for season, then say *qiān* again

Before you move on

What does 千 mean? ("Thousand".) Say it once more.

132.2 千 — a short fall over 十

The word first, then the character inside it.

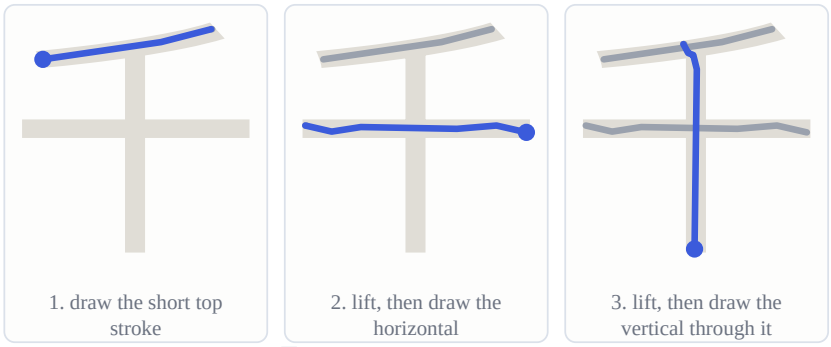
- *Recall:* say *qiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

十 百

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shí*, *bǎi*

Script — a short fall over 十

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 33.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 千 is written, stroke by stroke

千

Two pieces, top to bottom.
A short left-falling stroke at the top, from the right down to the left.
十**, two strokes**: the horizontal across, then the vertical down through it.
1 + 2 = three.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 千, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 千? (**Three**.) Which number you know sits under the fall? (十.) Which comes first, the bar or the vertical? (**The bar**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 千, pinned stroke paths and medians.

132.3 wàn — ten thousand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for season, then the Mandarin for thousand.

You'll want to know: wàn

wàn — "ten thousand".

wǒ xiǎng yǒu yíwàn kuài qián — I wish I had ten thousand yuan.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
The tone of 一 changes: yī is said yí before the fourth tone of wàn.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses this short way of writing the character 'ten thousands'; under its longer way of writing it gives the name of a dance and of an insect.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàn*
- *Say it: wàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng yǒu yíwàn kuài qián* — I wish I had ten thousand yuan.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for season, then the Mandarin for thousand, then say *wàn* again

Before you move on

What does wàn mean? ("Ten thousand".) Say it once more.

132.4 líng — zero

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for thousand, then the Mandarin for ten thousand.

You'll want to know: líng

líng — "zero".

tā yìbǎi líng yī suì le — He is a hundred and one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

líng is inherited from Middle Chinese *leng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to fall' and, after an older book, 'a gentle rain'. The sense zero is not given there; how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: líng*
- *Say it: líng*, once more
- *Say it: tā yìbǎi líng yī suì le* — He is a hundred and one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for thousand, then the Mandarin for ten thousand, then say *líng* again

Before you move on

What does líng mean? ("Zero".) Say it once more.

132.5 yígòng — altogether; in all

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ten thousand, then the Mandarin for zero.

You'll want to know: yígòng

yígòng — "altogether; in all".

> *wǒmen yígòng yǒu wǔ ge rén* — There are five of us in all.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
The tone of 一 changes: yī is said yí before the fourth tone of gòng.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yígòng is built from 一 'one' and *gòng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *gjowngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'together' and 'all'.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: yígòng*
- *Say it: yígòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yígòng yǒu wǔ ge rén* — There are five of us in all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ten thousand, then the Mandarin for zero, then say *yígòng* again

Before you move on

What does yígòng mean? ("Altogether; in all".) Say it once more.

132.6 shǔ — to count

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for zero, then the Mandarin for in all.

You'll want to know: shǔ

shǔ — "to count".

> *wǒ shǔ le yígòng yǒu bā ge* — I counted: there are eight in all.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǔ is inherited from Middle Chinese *srjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older book: 'to reckon'.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǔ*
- *Say it: shǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shǔ le yígòng yǒu bā ge* — I counted: there are eight in all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for zero, then the Mandarin for in all, then say *shǔ* again

Before you move on

What does shǔ mean? ("To count".) Say it once more.

Chapter 133

Housework

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I clean, tidy up, wipe and throw things away.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can say I clean, tidy up, wipe and throw things away.*

133.1 打扫 (dǎsǎo) — to clean (a room); to sweep

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in all, then the Mandarin for to count.

You'll want to know: 打扫

打扫 — *dǎsǎo* — "to clean (a room); to sweep".

> 今天我们一起打扫 *jīntiān wǒmen yìqǐ dǎsǎo* — Today we're cleaning up together.

The new character, in pieces: 扫 — the hand piece on the left, as in 打, and on the right three strokes: a bar that turns down, and two bars inside it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Two third tones: dǎsǎo is said dásǎo, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

打扫 (*dǎsǎo*) is built from 打 'to strike', here 'to do', and *sǎo* 'to sweep', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *sawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The regular sound change from *taengX* would not give the everyday *dǎ*; why is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎsǎo*
- *Say it: dǎsǎo*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒmen yìqǐ dǎsǎo* — Today we're cleaning up together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in all, then the Mandarin for to count, then say *dǎsǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 打扫 mean? ("To clean (a room); to sweep".) Say it once more.

133.2 扫 — the hand piece, then three bars

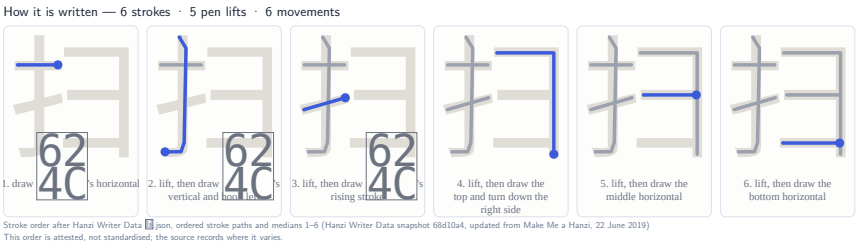
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dǎsǎo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  打 手

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dǎ*, *shǒu*

Script — the hand piece, then three bars



How 扫 is written, stroke by stroke

扫

Two pieces, left before right.

The hand piece, three strokes, as in 打: a horizontal, a vertical that hooks to the left at its foot, then a stroke that rises to the right across it.

The right piece, three strokes. A horizontal that turns down at its right end, a horizontal across the middle, then a horizontal along the foot, which runs out past the right side.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 扫, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which piece of 扫 comes from 打? (**The hand piece, on the left.**) How many strokes on the right? (**Three.**) Which bar runs out past the side? (**The bottom one.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 扫, pinned stroke paths and medians.

133.3 jiāwù — housework

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to count, then the Mandarin for to clean (a room).

You'll want to know: jiāwù

jiāwù — "housework".

wǒ bù xǐhuan zuò jiāwù — I don't like doing housework.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāwù is built from 家 'home' and *wù* 'affairs', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *mjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāwù*
- *Say it: jiāwù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù xǐhuan zuò jiāwù* — I don't like doing housework.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to count, then the Mandarin for to clean (a room), then say *jiāwù* again

Before you move on

What does jiāwù mean? ("Housework".) Say it once more.

133.4 shōushi — to tidy up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to clean (a room), then the Mandarin for housework.

You'll want to know: shōushi

shōushi — "to tidy up".

jīntiān wǒ shōushi fángjiān — Today I'm tidying my room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōushi is built from *shōu* 'to gather' and *shi*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw* and *dzyip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second with this very word, and with 'to pick up'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōushi*
- *Say it: shōushi*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒ shōushi fángjiān* — Today I'm tidying my room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to clean (a room), then the Mandarin for housework, then say *shōushi* again

Before you move on

What does shōushi mean? ("To tidy up".) Say it once more.

133.5 cā — to wipe

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for housework, then the Mandarin for to tidy up.

You'll want to know: cā

cā — "to wipe".

wǒ cā zhuōzi nǐ cā yǐzi — I'll wipe the table; you wipe the chairs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cā No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: cā*
- *Say it: cā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ cā zhuōzi nǐ cā yǐzi* — I'll wipe the table; you wipe the chairs.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for housework, then the Mandarin for to tidy up, then say *cā* again

Before you move on

What does cā mean? ("To wipe".) Say it once more.

133.6 dié — to fold

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to tidy up, then the Mandarin for to wipe.

You'll want to know: dié

dié — "to fold".

wǒ dié yīfu nǐ shōushi fángjiān — I'll fold the clothes; you tidy the room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dié is inherited from Middle Chinese *dep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'layered' and 'to pile up'; folding, a cloth laid in layers, is the likely step, though it is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: dié*
- *Say it: dié*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dié yīfu nǐ shōushi fángjiān* — I'll fold the clothes; you tidy the room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to tidy up, then the Mandarin for to wipe, then say *dié* again

Before you move on

What does dié mean? ("To fold".) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

Heavy and Soft

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a thing is heavy, soft, hard, empty or full.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can say a thing is heavy, soft, hard, empty or full.*

134.1 重 (zhòng) — heavy

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wipe, then the Mandarin for to fold.

You'll want to know: 重

重 — *zhòng* — "heavy".

> 这个太重了 *zhège tài zhòng le* — This one is too heavy.

The new character, in pieces: 重 — a short fall and a long bar on top, and under them 里, its vertical running up through the bar. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

重 (*zhòng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *drjowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'much', 'thick' and 'careful'. 'Heavy' is not among the glosses, so the step to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòng*
- *Say it: zhòng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège tài zhòng le* — This one is too heavy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wipe, then the Mandarin for to fold, then say *zhòng* again

Before you move on

What does 重 mean? ("Heavy".) Say it once more.

134.2 重 — a fall and a bar over 里

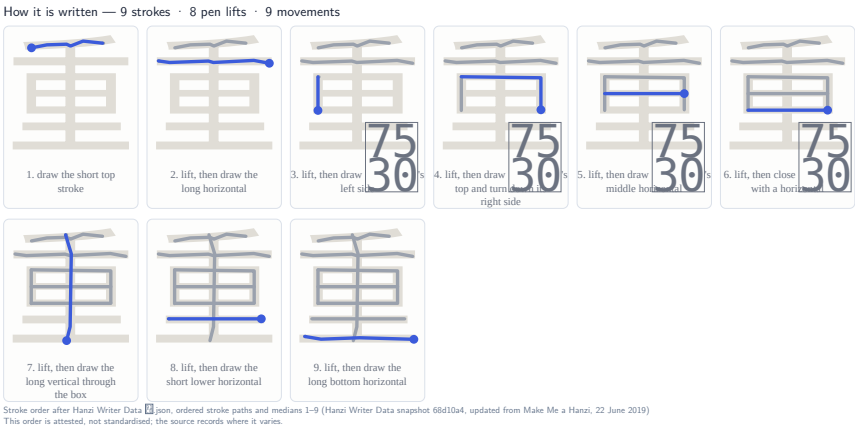
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhòng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  里 千

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lǐ*, *qiān*

Script — a fall and a bar over 里



How 重 *is written, stroke by stroke*

重

Two pieces, top to bottom.

A short left-falling stroke, from the right down to the left, then **a long horizontal** across the whole width, as 千 begins.

里, seven strokes, in the order your hand knows: the box (its left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, the bar that closes it), then the vertical, which here starts above the long bar and runs down through it and the box, then the two bars of the foot, the lower one longer.

2 + 7 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 重, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

What sits under the long bar of 重? (里.) Where does the vertical start? (**Above the long bar**.) Which is the last stroke? (**The long bar at the foot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 重, pinned stroke paths and medians.

134.3 ruǎn — soft

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fold, then the Mandarin for heavy.

You'll want to know: ruǎn

ruǎn — "soft".

zhè zhāng chuáng hěn ruǎn — This bed is soft.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ruǎn is inherited from Middle Chinese *nywenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'soft', under an older way of writing the character.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: ruǎn*
- *Say it: ruǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhè zhāng chuáng hěn ruǎn* — This bed is soft.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fold, then the Mandarin for heavy, then say *ruǎn* again

Before you move on

What does ruǎn mean? ("Soft".) Say it once more.

134.4 yìng — hard; stiff

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for heavy, then the Mandarin for soft.

You'll want to know: yìng

yìng — "hard; stiff".

zhège miànbāo tài yìng le — This bread is too hard.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìng is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngeangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'firm and sturdy'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìng*
- *Say it: yìng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège miànbāo tài yìng le* — This bread is too hard.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for heavy, then the Mandarin for soft, then say *yìng* again

Before you move on

What does yìng mean? ("Hard; stiff".) Say it once more.

134.5 kōng — empty

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for soft, then the Mandarin for hard to the touch.

You'll want to know: kōng

kōng — "empty".

bīngxiāng shì kōng de — The fridge is empty.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kōng is inherited from Middle Chinese *khuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'empty, hollow'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōng*
- *Say it: kōng*, once more
- *Say it: bīngxiāng shì kōng de* — The fridge is empty.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for soft, then the Mandarin for hard to the touch, then say *kōng* again

Before you move on

What does kōng mean? ("Empty".) Say it once more.

134.6 mǎn — full

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hard to the touch, then the Mandarin for empty.

You'll want to know: mǎn

mǎn — "full".

wǒ de bēizi mǎn le — My cup is full.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǎn is inherited from Middle Chinese *manX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'full' and 'to fill'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎn*
- *Say it: mǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de bēizi mǎn le* — My cup is full.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hard to the touch, then the Mandarin for empty, then say *mǎn* again

Before you move on

What does mǎn mean? ("Full".) Say it once more.

134.7 Looking back: from Quiet and Noisy to Heavy and Soft

Say the Mandarin for quiet and noisy.

Your turn

- *Say it:* quiet, noisy, bustling, convenient, interesting
- *Say it:* a sick person, to catch a cold, to have a fever, sore, to see a doctor
- *Say it:* spring, summer, autumn, winter, season
- *Say it:* thousand, ten thousand, zero, in all, to count
- *Say it:* to clean (a room), housework, to tidy up, to wipe, to fold
- *Say it:* heavy, soft, hard to the touch, empty, full
- *Read it:* 吵 病 春 千 扫 重 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Quiet? (*ānjìng.*) Noisy? (吵, *chǎo.*) Bustling? (*rènao.*) Convenient? (*fāngbiàn.*) Interesting? (*yǒuyìsi.*) A sick person? (病人, *bìngrén.*) To catch a cold? (*gǎnmào.*) To have a fever? (*fāshāo.*) Sore? (*téng.*) To see a doctor? (看病, *kànbìng.*) Spring? (春天, *chūntiān.*) Summer? (*xiàtiān.*) Autumn? (*qiūtiān.*) Winter? (*dōngtiān.*) Season? (*jìjié.*) Thousand? (千, *qiān.*) Ten thousand? (*wàn.*) Zero? (*líng.*) In all? (*yígòng.*) To count? (*shǔ.*) To clean (a room)? (打扫, *dǎsǎo.*) Housework? (*jiāwù.*) To tidy up? (*shōushi.*) To wipe? (*cā.*) To fold? (*dié.*) Heavy? (重, *zhòng.*) Soft? (*ruǎn.*) Hard to the touch? (*yìng.*) Empty? (*kōng.*) Full? (*mǎn.*)

Chapter 135

Sport

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about football, basketball, matches and working out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can talk about football, basketball, matches and working out.*

135.1 zúqiú — football; soccer

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for empty, then the Mandarin for full.

You'll want to know: zúqiú

zúqiú — "football; soccer".

> *wǒ xǐhuan zúqiú* — I love football.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zúqiú is built from *zú* 'foot' and *qiú* 'ball', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjowk* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses *gjuw* as 'fine jade', and under another way of writing it as a ball of fur that is struck.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: zúqiú*
- *Say it: zúqiú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan zúqiú* — I love football.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for empty, then the Mandarin for full, then say *zúqiú* again

Before you move on

What does zúqiú mean? ("Football; soccer".) Say it once more.

135.2 lánqiú — basketball

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for full, then the Mandarin for football.

You'll want to know: lánqiú

lánqiú — "basketball".

wǒ gēge hěn gāo tā xǐhuan lánqiú — My brother is tall, and he loves basketball.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lánqiú is built from *lán* 'basket' and *qiú* 'ball'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *lam* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a basket', a different word from the *lán* of blue; the second is the *qiú* of football.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: lánqiú*
- *Say it: lánqiú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēge hěn gāo tā xǐhuan lánqiú* — My brother is tall, and he loves basketball.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for full, then the Mandarin for football, then say *lánqiú* again

Before you move on

What does lánqiú mean? ("Basketball".) Say it once more.

135.3 tī — to kick

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for football, then the Mandarin for basketball.

You'll want to know: tī

tī — "to kick".

wǒmen qù tī zúqiú — We're off to play football.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tī The character is in the Guangyun as *thek* (in Baxter's transcription), but only in the name of a beast; the verb is not given there. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: tī*
- *Say it: tī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù tī zúqiú* — We're off to play football.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for football, then the Mandarin for basketball, then say *tī* again

Before you move on

What does tī mean? ("To kick".) Say it once more.

135.4 bǐsài — match; competition

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for basketball, then the Mandarin for to kick.

You'll want to know: bǐsài

bǐsài — "match; competition".

jīntiān yǒu zúqiú bǐsài — There's a football match today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǐsài is built from *bǐ* 'to compare' and *sài*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjijX* and *sojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'to repay'; how the pair came to mean a match is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǐsài*
- *Say it: bǐsài*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān yǒu zúqiú bǐsài* — There's a football match today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for basketball, then the Mandarin for to kick, then say *bǐsài* again

Before you move on

What does bǐsài mean? ("Match; competition".) Say it once more.

135.5 duànliàn — to exercise; to work out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to kick, then the Mandarin for a match.

You'll want to know: duànliàn

duànliàn — "to exercise; to work out".

wǒ xǐhuan zǎoshang duànliàn — I like working out in the morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duànliàn is built from *duàn* 'to forge iron' and *liàn* 'to refine metal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *twanH* and *lenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The pair said of the body is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: duànliàn*
- *Say it: duànliàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan zǎoshang duànliàn* — I like working out in the morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to kick, then the Mandarin for a match, then say *duànliàn* again

Before you move on

What does duànliàn mean? ("To exercise; to work out".) Say it once more.

Chapter 136

Because of the Weather

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give the weather as a reason: sunny, overcast, windy, thundery or cool.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can give the weather as a reason: sunny, overcast, windy, thundery or cool.*

136.1 qíngtiān — sunny day; fine weather

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a match, then the Mandarin for to work out.

You'll want to know: qíngtiān

qíngtiān — "sunny day; fine weather".

> *jīntiān shì qíngtiān wǒ xiǎng chūmén* — It's a sunny day, so I feel like going out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qíngtiān is built from *qíng* 'clear' and 天 'sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjeng* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'the sky clearing'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: qíngtiān*
- *Say it: qíngtiān*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān shì qíngtiān wǒ xiǎng chūmén* — It's a sunny day, so I feel like going out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a match, then the Mandarin for to work out, then say *qíngtiān* again

Before you move on

What does qíngtiān mean? ("Sunny day; fine weather".) Say it once more.

136.2 yīntiān — overcast day

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to work out, then the Mandarin for a sunny day.

You'll want to know: yīntiān

yīntiān — "overcast day".

jīntiān shì yīntiān yǒudiǎnr lěng — It's overcast today, and a bit cold.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīntiān is built from *yīn* 'shade, dark' and 天 'sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'im* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The first has the same old form as the 音 of 音乐 but is a different word.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīntiān*
- *Say it: yīntiān*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān shì yīntiān yǒudiǎnr lěng* — It's overcast today, and a bit cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to work out, then the Mandarin for a sunny day, then say *yīntiān* again

Before you move on

What does yīntiān mean? ("Overcast day".) Say it once more.

136.3 guāfēng — to be windy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sunny day, then the Mandarin for an overcast day.

You'll want to know: guāfēng

guāfēng — "to be windy".

wàibian guāfēng le — It's got windy outside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guāfēng is built from *guā* 'to scrape' and *fēng* 'wind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaet* and *pjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). For the wind the first was once written with another character, which has no Guangyun reading, so how scraping came into the word is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: guāfēng*
- *Say it: guāfēng*, once more
- *Say it: wàibian guāfēng le* — It's got windy outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sunny day, then the Mandarin for an overcast day, then say *guāfēng* again

Before you move on

What does guāfēng mean? ("To be windy".) Say it once more.

136.4 dǎléi — to thunder

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an overcast day, then the Mandarin for to be windy.

You'll want to know: dǎléi

dǎléi — "to thunder".

dǎléi le wǒmen bù chūmén le — It's thundering, so we're staying in.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎléi is built from 扌丁 'to strike' and *léi* 'thunder', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *lwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), though dǎ is not the sound *taengX* would regularly give. The dictionary explains the second, after an older book, as yin and yang pressing on each other.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎléi*
- *Say it: dǎléi*, once more
- *Say it: dǎléi le wǒmen bù chūmén le* — It's thundering, so we're staying in.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an overcast day, then the Mandarin for to be windy, then say *dǎléi* again

Before you move on

What does dǎléi mean? ("To thunder".) Say it once more.

136.5 liángkuai — pleasantly cool

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be windy, then the Mandarin for to thunder.

You'll want to know: liángkuai

liángkuai — "pleasantly cool".

qiūtiān hěn liángkuai — Autumn is nice and cool.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liángkuai is built from *liáng* 'cool' and 快, glossed 'to one's liking', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljang* and *khwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): cool and pleasant.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: liángkuai*
- *Say it: liángkuai*, once more
- *Say it: qiūtiān hěn liángkuai* — Autumn is nice and cool.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be windy, then the Mandarin for to thunder, then say *liángkuai* again

Before you move on

What does liángkuai mean? ("Pleasantly cool".) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

Holidays

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about festivals, the Spring Festival, the New Year and time off.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can talk about festivals, the Spring Festival, the New Year and time off.*

137.1 节日 (jiérì) — festival

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to thunder, then the Mandarin for pleasantly cool.

You'll want to know: 节日

节日 — *jiérì* — "festival".

> 今天是什么节日 *jīntiān shì shénme jiérì* — What festival is it today?

The new character, in pieces: 节 — the grass piece on top, a bar crossed by two short verticals, and under it a bar that turns down into a hook, with a long vertical through it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

节日 (*jiérì*) is built from 节 'a joint' and 日 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tset* and *nyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription);

the dictionary quotes an older book for the first: the joint of a bamboo. A festival as a joint in the year is the likely image, though it is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiérì*
- *Say it: jiérì*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān shì shénme jiérì* — What festival is it today?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to thunder, then the Mandarin for pleasantly cool, then say *jiérì* again

Before you move on

What does 节日 mean? ("Festival".) Say it once more.

137.2 节 — the grass piece over a hook

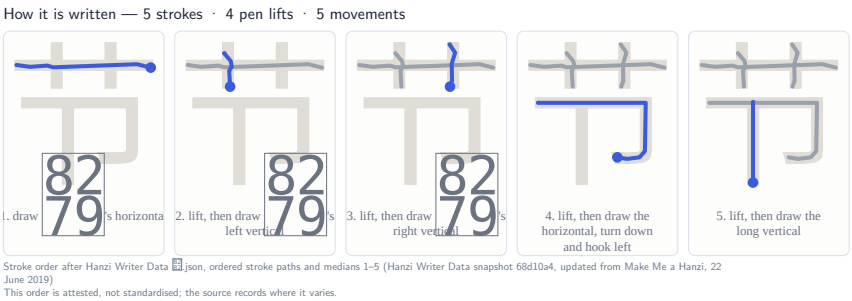
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiérì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  菜 日

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *cài*, *rì*

Script — the grass piece over a hook



How 节 *is written, stroke by stroke*

节

Two pieces, top to bottom.

The grass piece, three strokes, as on top of 菜: a horizontal across, then a short vertical on the left and a short vertical on the right, both crossing it.

The lower piece, two strokes. A horizontal that turns down and ends in a hook to the left, then a long vertical down through it to the foot.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 节, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 节? (**Two**.) How many strokes in the grass piece? (**Three**.) Which stroke is the last? (**The long vertical**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 节, pinned stroke paths and medians.

137.3 春节 (Chūnjié) — the Spring Festival; Chinese New Year

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pleasantly cool, then the Mandarin for festival.

You'll want to know: 春节

春节 — *Chūnjié* — "the Spring Festival; Chinese New Year".

春节前大家都打扫 *Chūnjié qián dàjiā dōu dǎsǎo* — Before the festival, everybody cleans the house.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

春节 (*Chūnjié*) is built from 春 'spring' and 节 'festival', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwin* and *tset* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the festival at the head of spring.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: Chūnjié*
- *Say it: Chūnjié*, once more
- *Say it: Chūnjié qián dàjiā dōu dǎsǎo* — Before the festival, everybody cleans the house.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pleasantly cool, then the Mandarin for festival, then say *Chūnjié* again

Before you move on

What does 春节 mean? ("The Spring Festival; Chinese New Year".) Say it once more.

137.4 guònián — to celebrate the New Year

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for festival, then the Mandarin for Chinese New Year.

You'll want to know: guònián

guònián — "to celebrate the New Year".

> *guònián wǒmen chī jiǎozi* — We eat dumplings to see in the new year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guònián is built from *guò* 'to pass' and 年 'year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaH* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The pair is not given there; seeing the year through is the plain picture, but how it came to mean celebrating is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: guònián*
- *Say it: guònián*, once more
- *Say it: guònián wǒmen chī jiǎozi* — We eat dumplings to see in the new year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for festival, then the Mandarin for Chinese New Year, then say *guònián* again

Before you move on

What does guònián mean? ("To celebrate the New Year".) Say it once more.

137.5 fàngjià — to have time off; to go on holiday

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for Chinese New Year, then the Mandarin for to celebrate the New Year.

You'll want to know: fàngjià

fàngjià — "to have time off; to go on holiday".

míngtiān wǒmen fàngjià — We're off tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàngjià is built from *fàng* 'to let go' and *jià* 'leave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjangH* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to borrow' and 'leave from duty'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàngjià*
- *Say it: fàngjià*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǒmen fàngjià* — We're off tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for Chinese New Year, then the Mandarin for to celebrate the New Year, then say *fàngjià* again

Before you move on

What does fàngjià mean? ("To have time off; to go on holiday".) Say it once more.

137.6 jiàqī — holidays; time off

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to celebrate the New Year, then the Mandarin for to have time off.

You'll want to know: jiàqī

jiàqī — "holidays; time off".

> *fàngjià le jiàqī nǐ xiǎng qù nǎr* — We're on holiday now; where would you like to go?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàqī is built from *jià* 'leave' and 期 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaeH* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàqī*
- *Say it: jiàqī*, once more
- *Say it: fàngjià le jiàqī nǐ xiǎng qù nǎr* — We're on holiday now; where would you like to go?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to celebrate the New Year, then the Mandarin for to have time off, then say *jiàqī* again

Before you move on

What does jiàqī mean? ("Holidays; time off".) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

Every and Other

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say every, myself, other people, all and the others.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say every, myself, other people, all and the others.*

138.1 每 (měi) — every; each

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have time off, then the Mandarin for the holidays.

You'll want to know: 每

每 — *měi* — "every; each".

> 我们每个星期六都打扫 *wǒmen měi ge xīngqīliù dōu dǎsǎo* — We clean the house every Saturday.

The new character, in pieces: 每 — a short fall and a short bar on top, then a box: a vertical that turns right along the bottom, a bar that turns down the right side and hooks, a dot, a long bar across, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

每 (*měi*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *mwojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'frequently' and as a particle. 'Every' is not among the glosses, so how it got that sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: měi*
- *Say it: měi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen měi ge xīngqīliù dōu dǎsǎo* — We clean the house every Saturday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have time off, then the Mandarin for the holidays, then say *měi* again

Before you move on

What does 每 mean? ("Every; each".) Say it once more.

138.2 每 — a fall and a bar over a dotted box

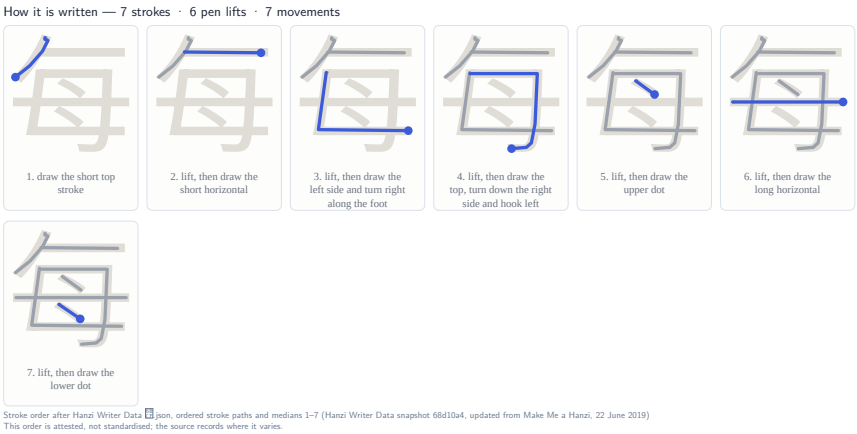
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *měi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  天 个

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tiān*, *gè*

Script — a fall and a bar over a dotted box



How 每 is written, stroke by stroke

每

Two pieces, top to bottom.

The top, two strokes. A short left-falling stroke, then a short horizontal running right from it.

The box, five strokes. A vertical that runs down the left and turns right along the bottom; a horizontal across the top that turns down the right side, past the bottom, and hooks to the left; a dot inside the upper half; a long horizontal across the middle, out past both sides; then a dot inside the lower half.

2 + 5 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 每, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 每? (**Seven.**) Which stroke runs out past both sides? (**The long horizontal across the middle.**) Where are the

two dots? (**Inside the box, one above that bar and one below it**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 每, pinned stroke paths and medians.

138.3 zìjǐ — oneself

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the holidays, then the Mandarin for each.

You'll want to know: zìjǐ

zìjǐ — "oneself".

wǒ zìjǐ zuòfàn — I cook for myself.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zìjǐ is built from *zì* 'from' and *jǐ* 'self', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *kiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'one's own body'.

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìjǐ*
- *Say it: zìjǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zìjǐ zuòfàn* — I cook for myself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the holidays, then the Mandarin for each, then say *zìjǐ* again

Before you move on

What does zìjǐ mean? ("Oneself".) Say it once more.

138.4 biérén — other people

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for each, then the Mandarin for oneself.

You'll want to know: biérén

biérén — "other people".

wǒ de shū wǒ bù xiǎng gěi biérén — I don't want to give my books to anyone else.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biérén is built from *bié* 'different', as in *biéde*, and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjet* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: biérén*
- *Say it: biérén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shū wǒ bù xiǎng gěi biérén* — I don't want to give my books to anyone else.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for each, then the Mandarin for oneself, then say *biérén* again

Before you move on

What does biérén mean? ("Other people".) Say it once more.

138.5 suǒyǒu — all; every

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for oneself, then the Mandarin for other people.

You'll want to know: suǒyǒu

suǒyǒu — "all; every".

> *suǒyǒu de rén dōu lái le* — Everyone has come.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: suǒyǒu is said suóyǒu, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suǒyǒu is built from *suǒ* 'a place', the *suǒ* of *suǒyǐ*, and 有 'to have', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjoX* and *hjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How the pair came to mean all is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: suǒyǒu*
- *Say it: suǒyǒu*, once more
- *Say it: suǒyǒu de rén dōu lái le* — Everyone has come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for oneself, then the Mandarin for other people, then say *suǒyǒu* again

Before you move on

What does suǒyǒu mean? ("All; every".) Say it once more.

138.6 qítā — other; the others

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for other people, then the Mandarin for every single.

You'll want to know: qítā

qítā — "other; the others".

> *wǒ xǐhuan zhège qítā de wǒ bú yào* — I like this one; I don't want the others.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qítā is built from *qí*, which the dictionary lists as a particle, and 他, glossed 'not I', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gi* and *tha* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for pointing things out.

Your turn

- *Say it: qítā*
- *Say it: qítā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan zhège qítā de wǒ bú yào* — I like this one; I don't want the others.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for other people, then the Mandarin for every single, then say *qítā* again

Before you move on

What does qítā mean? ("Other; the others".) Say it once more.

Chapter 139

Colours and Shapes

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name green, yellow, grey and pink, and say that something is round.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can name green, yellow, grey and pink, and say that something is round.*

139.1 lǜ — green

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for every single, then the Mandarin for the others.

You'll want to know: lǜ

lǜ — "green".

> *chūntiān de cǎo hěn lǜ* — In spring the grass is very green.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǜ is inherited from Middle Chinese *ljowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the colour of blue and yellow'. The regular sound change would give *lù*; why the everyday word is *lǜ* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǜ*
- *Say it: lǜ*, once more
- *Say it: chūntiān de cǎo hěn lǜ* — In spring the grass is very green.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for every single, then the Mandarin for the others, then say *lǜ* again

Before you move on

What does lǜ mean? ("Green".) Say it once more.

139.2 huáng — yellow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the others, then the Mandarin for green.

You'll want to know: huáng

huáng — "yellow".

zhège píngguǒ shì huáng de — This apple is a yellow one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huáng is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the colour of the centre'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: huáng*
- *Say it: huáng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège píngguǒ shì huáng de* — This apple is a yellow one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the others, then the Mandarin for green, then say *huáng* again

Before you move on

What does huáng mean? ("Yellow".) Say it once more.

139.3 huī — grey

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for green, then the Mandarin for yellow.

You'll want to know: huī

huī — "grey".

wǒ de māo shì huī de — My cat is a grey one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huī is inherited from Middle Chinese *xwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older book: 'dead fire', that is, ash. The colour of ash is the likely step to grey, though it is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: huī*
- *Say it: huī*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ de māo shì huī de* — My cat is a grey one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for green, then the Mandarin for yellow, then say *huī* again

Before you move on

What does huī mean? ("Grey".) Say it once more.

139.4 yuán — round

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for yellow, then the Mandarin for grey.

You'll want to know: yuán

yuán — "round".

zhè zhāng zhuōzi shì yuán de — This table is a round one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuán is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the form of heaven'. The plain sense round is not among the glosses, so the step is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuán*
- *Say it: yuán*, once more
- *Say it: zhè zhāng zhuōzi shì yuán de* — This table is a round one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for yellow, then the Mandarin for grey, then say *yuán* again

Before you move on

What does yuán mean? (“Round”.) Say it once more.

139.5 fěnhóng — pink

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grey, then the Mandarin for round.

You’ll want to know: fěnhóng

fěnhóng — “pink”.

tā de màozi shì fěnhóng de — Her hat is a pink one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fěnhóng is built from *fěn* ’powder’ and *hóng* ’red’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjunX* and *huwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription): red as pale as face powder. The dictionary glosses the first with a powder made by burning lead.

What you’ve built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: fěnhóng*
- *Say it: fěnhóng*, once more
- *Say it: tā de màozi shì fěnhóng de* — Her hat is a pink one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grey, then the Mandarin for round, then say *fěnhóng* again

Before you move on

What does fěnhóng mean? (“Pink”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 140

First and Half

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say first, half, how many times, the most, and work a sum out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say first, half, how many times, the most, and work a sum out.*

140.1 dìyī — first

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for round, then the Mandarin for pink.

You'll want to know: dìyī

dìyī — "first".

zhè shì wǒ de dìyī ge shǒujī — This is my first phone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

一 keeps its first tone here: in a number that gives an order, yī does not change its tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìyī is built from *dì* 'order, rank' and 一 'one', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dejH* and *'jit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìyī*
- *Say it: dìyī*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de dìyī ge shǒujī* — This is my first phone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for round, then the Mandarin for pink, then say *dìyī* again

Before you move on

What does dìyī mean? ("First".) Say it once more.

140.2 一半 (yíbàn) — one half; half (of something)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pink, then the Mandarin for first.

You'll want to know: 一半

一半 — *yíbàn* — "one half; half (of something)".

两千的一半是一千 *liǎngqiān de yíbàn shì yìqiān* — Half of two thousand is one thousand.

The new character, in pieces: 半 — two short dots on top, two bars, and a long vertical down through them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The tone of 一 changes: yī is said yí before the fourth tone of bàn.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一半 (*yíbàn*) is built from 一 'one' and 半, inherited from Middle Chinese *'jit* and *panH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'a thing divided in the middle', the *bàn* of half past.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíbàn*
- *Say it: yíbàn*, once more
- *Say it: liǎngqiān de yíbàn shì yìqiān* — Half of two thousand is one thousand.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pink, then the Mandarin for first, then say *yíbàn* again

Before you move on

What does 一半 mean? ("One half; half (of something)".) Say it once more.

140.3 半 — two dots, two bars, one vertical

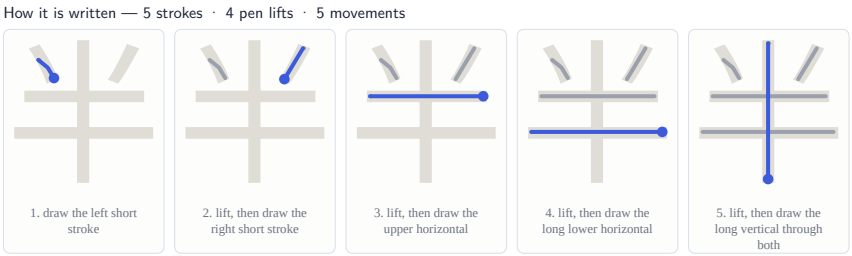
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yíbàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

二 千

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *èr*, *qiān*

Script — two dots, two bars, one vertical



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data .json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–5 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 半 is written, stroke by stroke

半

One piece, five strokes.

Two short dots at the top, leaning toward each other: the left one falls to the lower right, the right one to the lower left.

Two horizontals, short over long, the two bars of 二.

A long vertical from above the shorter bar, straight down through both to the foot.

2 + 2 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 半, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 半? (**Five**.) Which way do the two dots lean? (**Toward each other**.) What comes last? (**The long vertical**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 半, pinned stroke paths and medians.

140.4 cì — time (one occurrence)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for first, then the Mandarin for one half.

You'll want to know: cì

cì — "time (one occurrence)".

zhè shì wǒ dìyī cì lái Běijīng — This is my first time in Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cì is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'order, sequence' and 'a halt on a journey'.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: cì*
- *Say it: cì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ dìyī cì lái Běijīng* — This is my first time in Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for first, then the Mandarin for one half, then say *cì* again

Before you move on

What does cì mean? ("Time (one occurrence)".) Say it once more.

140.5 zuì — most

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one half, then the Mandarin for one occurrence.

You'll want to know: zuì

zuì — "most".

wǒ zuì xǐhuan chūntiān — Spring is my favourite.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuì is inherited from Middle Chinese *tswajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'utmost'.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuì*
- *Say it: zuì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì xǐhuan chūntiān* — Spring is my favourite.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one half, then the Mandarin for one occurrence, then say *zuì* again

Before you move on

What does zuì mean? ("Most".) Say it once more.

140.6 suàn — to calculate; to work out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one occurrence, then the Mandarin for most.

You'll want to know: suàn

suàn — "to calculate; to work out".

wǒ suàn le yígòng shì sānshí kuài — I've worked it out: thirty yuan in all.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *swanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the number of things'. The regular sound change would give a third tone, *suǎn*, not *suàn*; why is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for counting.

Your turn

- *Say it: suàn*
- *Say it: suàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ suàn le yígòng shì sānshí kuài* — I've worked it out: thirty yuan in all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one occurrence, then the Mandarin for most, then say *suàn* again

Before you move on

What does suàn mean? ("To calculate; to work out".) Say it once more.

140.7 Looking back: from Sport to First and Half

Say the Mandarin for football and basketball.

Your turn

- *Say it:* football, basketball, to kick, a match, to work out
- *Say it:* a sunny day, an overcast day, to be windy, to thunder, pleasantly cool
- *Say it:* festival, Chinese New Year, to celebrate the New Year, to have time off, the holidays
- *Say it:* each, oneself, other people, every single, the others
- *Say it:* green, yellow, grey, round, pink
- *Say it:* first, one half, one occurrence, most, to calculate
- *Read it:* 节 每 半 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Football? (*zúqiú.*) Basketball? (*lánqiú.*) To kick? (*tī.*) A match? (*bǐsài.*) To work out? (*duànliàn.*) A sunny day? (*qíngtiān.*) An

overcast day? (*yīntiān.*) To be windy? (*guāfēng.*) To thunder? (*dǎléi.*) Pleasantly cool? (*liángkuai.*) Festival? (节日, *jiérì.*) Chinese New Year? (春节, *Chūnjié.*) To celebrate the New Year? (*guònián.*) To have time off? (*fàngjià.*) The holidays? (*jiàqī.*) Each? (每, *měi.*) Oneself? (*zìjǐ.*) Other people? (*biérén.*) Every single? (*suǒyǒu.*) The others? (*qítā.*) Green? (*lǜ.*) Yellow? (*huáng.*) Grey? (*huī.*) Round? (*yuán.*) Pink? (*fěnhóng.*) First? (*dìyī.*) One half? (一半, *yíbàn.*) One occurrence? (*cì.*) Most? (*zuì.*) To calculate? (*suàn.*)

Chapter 141

Travel and Fun

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about travelling, games, going round the shops, walks and fishing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can talk about travelling, games, going round the shops, walks and fishing.*

141.1 lǚyóu — to travel; to tour

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for most, then the Mandarin for to calculate.

You'll want to know: lǚyóu

lǚyóu — "to travel; to tour".

> *wǒ xǐhuan lǚyóu* — I love travelling.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǚyóu is built from *lǚ* and *yóu*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljoX* and *yuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a body of troops' and the second 'to float, to roam', the *yóu* of *yóuyǒng*. 'Journey' for the first is not given there; how it got that sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǚyóu*
- *Say it: lǚyóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan lǚyóu* — I love travelling.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for most, then the Mandarin for to calculate, then say *lǚyóu* again

Before you move on

What does lǚyóu mean? ("To travel; to tour".) Say it once more.

141.2 yóuxì — game

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to calculate, then the Mandarin for to travel.

You'll want to know: yóuxì

yóuxì — "game".

wǒ érzi hěn xǐhuan wán yóuxì — My son loves playing games.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóuxì is built from *yóu* 'to roam' and *xì* 'to play, to tease', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *xjeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóuxì*
- *Say it: yóuxì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ érzi hěn xǐhuan wán yóuxì* — My son loves playing games.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to calculate, then the Mandarin for to travel, then say *yóuxì* again

Before you move on

What does yóuxì mean? ("Game".) Say it once more.

141.3 guàngjiē — to stroll the shops; to go window-shopping

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to travel, then the Mandarin for a game.

You'll want to know: guàngjiē

guàngjiē — "to stroll the shops; to go window-shopping".

zhōumò wǒmen qù guàngjiē — At the weekend we're going round the shops.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guàngjiē is built from *guàng* and *jiē* 'street', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjwangX* and *kea* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'the look of walking'; the regular sound change would give it a third tone, so the fourth tone of *guàng* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: guàngjiē*
- *Say it: guàngjiē*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen qù guàngjiē* — At the weekend we're going round the shops.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to travel, then the Mandarin for a game, then say *guàngjiē* again

Before you move on

What does guàngjiē mean? ("To stroll the shops; to go window-shopping".) Say it once more.

141.4 sànbù — to take a walk

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a game, then the Mandarin for to stroll the shops.

You'll want to know: sànbù

sànbù — "to take a walk".

wǎnfàn yǐhòu wǒmen qù sànbù — After dinner we go for a walk.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sànbù is built from *sàn* 'to scatter, to spread out' and *bù* 'step', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sanH* and *buH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): steps let loose.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: sànbù*
- *Say it: sànbù*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnfàn yǐhòu wǒmen qù sànbù* — After dinner we go for a walk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a game, then the Mandarin for to stroll the shops, then say *sànbù* again

Before you move on

What does sànbù mean? ("To take a walk".) Say it once more.

141.5 diàoyú — to go fishing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stroll the shops, then the Mandarin for to take a walk.

You'll want to know: diàoyú

diàoyú — "to go fishing".

wǒ bàba xǐhuan diàoyú — My dad loves fishing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diàoyú is built from *diào* 'to angle' and *yú* 'fish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tewH* and *ngjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first with this very word, 'to fish'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: diàoyú*
- *Say it: diàoyú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba xǐhuan diàoyú* — My dad loves fishing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stroll the shops, then the Mandarin for to take a walk, then say *diàoyú* again

Before you move on

What does diàoyú mean? ("To go fishing".) Say it once more.

Chapter 142

More Housework

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about mopping, rubbish, drying things in the sun, sorting things out and watering the plants.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can talk about mopping, rubbish, drying things in the sun, sorting things out and watering the plants.*

142.1 tuōdì — to mop the floor

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take a walk, then the Mandarin for to go fishing.

You'll want to know: tuōdì

tuōdì — "to mop the floor".

> *wǒ měitiān tuōdì* — I mop the floor every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuōdì is built from *tuō* 'to drag' and *dì* 'ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tha* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to drag' under an older way of writing it, and notes that it is popularly written the modern way; *tha* is also the old form of the word for he, a different word.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuōdì*
- *Say it: tuōdì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān tuōdì* — I mop the floor every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take a walk, then the Mandarin for to go fishing, then say *tuōdì* again

Before you move on

What does tuōdì mean? ("To mop the floor".) Say it once more.

142.2 lājī — rubbish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go fishing, then the Mandarin for to mop the floor.

You'll want to know: lājī

lājī — "rubbish".

ménkǒu yǒu lājī — There's rubbish by the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lājī No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: lājī*
- *Say it: lājī*, once more
- *Say it: ménkǒu yǒu lājī* — There's rubbish by the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go fishing, then the Mandarin for to mop the floor, then say *lājī* again

Before you move on

What does lājī mean? ("Rubbish".) Say it once more.

142.3 shài — to dry in the sun

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to mop the floor, then the Mandarin for rubbish.

You'll want to know: shài

shài — "to dry in the sun".

jīntiān shì qíngtiān wǒmen shài yīfu — It's a sunny day, so we're putting the washing out to dry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shài is inherited from Middle Chinese *sreaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to sun, to expose to the sun'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: shài*
- *Say it: shài*, once more

- *Say it: jīntiān shì qíngtiān wǒmen shài yīfu* — It's a sunny day, so we're putting the washing out to dry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to mop the floor, then the Mandarin for rubbish, then say *shài* again

Before you move on

What does shài mean? ("To dry in the sun".) Say it once more.

142.4 zhěnglǐ — to sort out; to put in order

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for rubbish, then the Mandarin for to dry in the sun.

You'll want to know: zhěnglǐ

zhěnglǐ — "to sort out; to put in order".

wǒ zhěnglǐ le wǒ de shū — I've sorted out my books.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: zhěnglǐ is said zhénglǐ, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhěnglǐ is built from *zhěng* 'straight, even' and *lǐ* 'to put in order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengX* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary quotes an older book for the second: to work jade.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhěnglǐ*
- *Say it: zhěnglǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhěnglǐ le wǒ de shū* — I've sorted out my books.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for rubbish, then the Mandarin for to dry in the sun, then say *zhěnglǐ* again

Before you move on

What does zhěnglǐ mean? ("To sort out; to put in order".) Say it once more.

142.5 jiāohuā — to water the plants

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dry in the sun, then the Mandarin for to sort out.

You'll want to know: jiāohuā

jiāohuā — "to water the plants".

jīntiān nǐ jiāohuā wǒ tuōdì — Today you water the plants and I'll mop the floor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāohuā is built from *jiāo* 'to pour water on' and *huā* 'flower', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kew* and *xwae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāohuā*
- *Say it: jiāohuā*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān nǐ jiāohuā wǒ tuōdì* — Today you water the plants and I'll mop the floor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dry in the sun, then the Mandarin for to sort out, then say *jiāohuā* again

Before you move on

What does jiāohuā mean? ("To water the plants".) Say it once more.

Chapter 143

Clock Words

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say seconds and minutes, the minutes before the hour, and when things begin and end.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can say seconds and minutes, the minutes before the hour, and when things begin and end.*

143.1 miǎo — second (of time)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sort out, then the Mandarin for to water the plants.

You'll want to know: miǎo

miǎo — "second (of time)".

> *qǐng děng wǔ miǎo* — Please wait five seconds.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

miǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjiewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the beard of grain'. The tiny unit of time is not given there; the step from something very fine is the likely one, but it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: miǎo*
- *Say it: miǎo*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng děng wǔ miǎo* — Please wait five seconds.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sort out, then the Mandarin for to water the plants, then say *miǎo* again

Before you move on

What does miǎo mean? ("Second (of time)".) Say it once more.

143.2 fēnzhōng — minute (a length of time)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to water the plants, then the Mandarin for second (of time).

You'll want to know: fēnzhōng

fēnzhōng — "minute (a length of time)".

shí fēnzhōng yǐhòu wǒmen zǒu — We're leaving in ten minutes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēnzhōng is built from *fēn*, the minute of the clock, and *zhōng* 'bell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjun* and *tsyowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as a musical instrument.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēnzhōng*
- *Say it: fēnzhōng*, once more
- *Say it: shí fēnzhōng yǐhòu wǒmen zǒu* — We're leaving in ten minutes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to water the plants, then the Mandarin for second (of time), then say *fēnzhōng* again

Before you move on

What does fēnzhōng mean? ("Minute (a length of time)".) Say it once more.

143.3 chà — to be short of; to (before the hour)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for second (of time), then the Mandarin for minute (a length of time).

You'll want to know: chà

chà — "to be short of; to (before the hour)".

xiànzài chà wǔ fēn bā diǎn — It's five to eight now.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chà is inherited from Middle Chinese, where the Guangyun lists several readings; *tsrhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription) is glossed 'to choose' and 'amiss'. None of them gives the fourth tone of *chà* by the regular sound change, so how this reading came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: chà*
- *Say it: chà*, once more
- *Say it: xiànzài chà wǔ fēn bā diǎn* — It's five to eight now.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for second (of time), then the Mandarin for minute (a length of time), then say *chà* again

Before you move on

What does chà mean? ("To be short of; to (before the hour)".) Say it once more.

143.4 zhǔnshí — on time; punctual

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for minute (a length of time), then the Mandarin for to be short of.

You'll want to know: zhǔnshí

zhǔnshí — "on time; punctual".

huǒchē hěn zhǔnshí — The trains run on time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔnshí is built from *zhǔn* 'level, a standard', the *zhǔn* of *zhǔnbèi*, and 时 'time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsywinX* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): true to the time.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔnshí*
- *Say it: zhǔnshí*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē hěn zhǔnshí* — The trains run on time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for minute (a length of time), then the Mandarin for to be short of, then say *zhǔnshí* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔnshí mean? ("On time; punctual".) Say it once more.

143.5 半天 (bàntiān) — a long while; half a day

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be short of, then the Mandarin for punctual.

You'll want to know: 半天

半天 — *bàntiān* — "a long while; half a day".

wǒ děng le bàntiān — I waited for ages.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

半天 (*bàntiān*) is built from 半 'half' and 天 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *panH* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): half a day, and in everyday talk, often with a sigh, a long while.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàntiān*
- *Say it: bàntiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ děng le bàntiān* — I waited for ages.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be short of, then the Mandarin for punctual, then say *bàntiān* again

Before you move on

What does 半天 mean? ("A long while; half a day".) Say it once more.

Chapter 144

Easy and Important

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a thing is important, easy, simple or special, and what I think of it.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say a thing is important, easy, simple or special, and what I think of it.*

144.1 重要 (zhòngyào) — important

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for punctual, then the Mandarin for a long while.

You'll want to know: 重要

重要 — *zhòngyào* — "important".

> 每天喝水很重要 *měitiān hē shuǐ hěn zhòngyào* — Drinking water every day is important.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

重要 (*zhòngyào*) is built from 重 'heavy' and 要, glossed 'to bind, to agree', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjowngX* and *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How the pair came to mean important is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòngyào*
- *Say it: zhòngyào*, once more
- *Say it: měitiān hē shuǐ hěn zhòngyào* — Drinking water every day is important.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for punctual, then the Mandarin for a long while, then say *zhòngyào* again

Before you move on

What does 重要 mean? ("Important".) Say it once more.

144.2 róngyì — easy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a long while, then the Mandarin for important.

You'll want to know: róngyì

róngyì — "easy".

hànzì bù róngyì — Chinese characters aren't easy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

róngyì is built from *róng* 'to hold' and *yì* 'easy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yowng* and *yeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'hard and easy' and 'simple'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: róngyì*
- *Say it: róngyì*, once more
- *Say it: hànzì bù róngyì* — Chinese characters aren't easy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a long while, then the Mandarin for important, then say *róngyì* again

Before you move on

What does róngyì mean? ("Easy".) Say it once more.

144.3 jiǎndān — simple

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for important, then the Mandarin for easy.

You'll want to know: jiǎndān

jiǎndān — "simple".

zhège hěn jiǎndān — This one's simple.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎndān is built from *jiǎn* 'brief' and *dān* 'single', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keanX* and *tan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a slip of bamboo for writing on, and 'brief'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎndān*
- *Say it: jiǎndān*, once more
- *Say it: zhège hěn jiǎndān* — This one's simple.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for important, then the Mandarin for easy, then say *jiǎndān* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎndān mean? ("Simple".) Say it once more.

144.4 tèbié — special; especially

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for easy, then the Mandarin for simple.

You'll want to know: tèbié

tèbié — "special; especially".

zhège dìfang hěn tèbié — This place is special.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tèbié is built from *tè* 'alone' and *bié* 'different', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dok* and *bjet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: tèbié*
- *Say it: tèbié*, once more

- *Say it: zhège dìfang hěn tèbié* — This place is special.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for easy, then the Mandarin for simple, then say *tèbié* again

Before you move on

What does tèbié mean? ("Special; especially".) Say it once more.

144.5 juéde — to find (that); to feel; to think (that)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for simple, then the Mandarin for special.

You'll want to know: juéde

juéde — "to find (that); to feel; to think (that)".

wǒ juéde hànyǔ hěn yǒuyìsi — I find Chinese interesting.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

juéde is built from *jué*, glossed 'to understand' and 'to wake', and *de*, from a word glossed 'to get', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewk* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: juéde*
- *Say it: juéde*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde hànyǔ hěn yǒuyìsi* — I find Chinese interesting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for simple, then the Mandarin for special, then say *juéde* again

Before you move on

What does juéde mean? ("To find (that); to feel; to think (that)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

Late Again

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give reasons for being late: the train, the alarm clock, a lie-in.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can give reasons for being late: the train, the alarm clock, a lie-in.*

145.1 yuányīn — reason; cause

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for special, then the Mandarin for to find (that).

You'll want to know: yuányīn

yuányīn — "reason; cause".

> *wǒ bù zhīdào shì shénme yuányīn* — I don't know what the reason is.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuányīn is built from *yuán* and 因 'because', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwon* and *'jin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a broad plain' and the second 'to follow from'; how the first came to mean origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuányīn*
- *Say it: yuányīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù zhīdào shì shénme yuányīn* — I don't know what the reason is.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for special, then the Mandarin for to find (that), then say *yuányīn* again

Before you move on

What does yuányīn mean? ("Reason; cause".) Say it once more.

145.2 晚点 (wǎndiǎn) — to run behind schedule; to be late (of a train or plane)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to find (that), then the Mandarin for a reason.

You'll want to know: 晚点

晚点 — *wǎndiǎn* — "to run behind schedule; to be late (of a train or plane)".

> 火车晚点了半个小时 *huǒchē wǎndiǎn le bàn ge xiǎoshí* — The train was half an hour late.

Two third tones: wǎndiǎn is said wándiǎn, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

晚点 (*wǎndiǎn*) is built from 晚 and 点, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonX* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'dusk' and 'a dot'. Late against the hour is the sense of the pair, which the dictionary does not give.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎndiǎn*
- *Say it: wǎndiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē wǎndiǎn le bàn ge xiǎoshí* — The train was half an hour late.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to find (that), then the Mandarin for a reason, then say *wǎndiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 晚点 mean? ("To run behind schedule; to be late (of a train or plane)".) Say it once more.

145.3 nàozhōng — alarm clock

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a reason, then the Mandarin for to run behind schedule.

You'll want to know: nàozhōng

nàozhōng — "alarm clock".

wǒ méiyǒu nàozhōng suǒyǐ wǒ chídào le — I haven't got an alarm clock, so I was late.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nàozhōng is built from *nào* 'to stir up', the *nao* of *rènao*, and *zhōng* 'bell', the *zhōng* of *fēnzhōng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nraewH* and *tsyowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a bell that stirs you up.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: nàozhōng*
- *Say it: nàozhōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ méiyǒu nàozhōng suǒyǐ wǒ chídào le* — I haven't got an alarm clock, so I was late.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a reason, then the Mandarin for to run behind schedule, then say *nàozhōng* again

Before you move on

What does nàozhōng mean? ("Alarm clock".) Say it once more.

145.4 shuì lǎnjiào — to sleep in; to lie in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to run behind schedule, then the Mandarin for alarm clock.

You'll want to know: shuì lǎnjiào

shuì lǎnjiào — "to sleep in; to lie in".

jīntiān shì xīngqītiān wǒ xiǎng shuì lǎnjiào — It's Sunday, so I want a lie-in.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuì lǎnjiào is built from *shuì* 'to sleep', *lǎn* 'lazy' and *jiào* 'a sleep', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyweH*, *lanX* and *kaewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the last with the word *shuìjiào* itself.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuì lǎnjiào*
- *Say it: shuì lǎnjiào*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān shì xīngqītiān wǒ xiǎng shuì lǎnjiào* — It's Sunday, so I want a lie-in.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to run behind schedule, then the Mandarin for alarm clock, then say *shuì lǎnjiào* again

Before you move on

What does shuì lǎnjiào mean? ("To sleep in; to lie in".) Say it once more.

145.5 gǎnkuài — quickly; hurry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for alarm clock, then the Mandarin for to lie in.

You'll want to know: gǎnkuài

gǎnkuài — "quickly; hurry".

bā diǎn shàngkè wǒmen gǎnkuài zǒu — Class is at eight, so let's hurry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎnkuài is built from *gǎn* 'to hurry' and 快 'fast'. 快 is inherited from Middle Chinese *khwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnkuài*
- *Say it: gǎnkuài*, once more
- *Say it: bā diǎn shàngkè wǒmen gǎnkuài zǒu* — Class is at eight, so let's hurry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for alarm clock, then the Mandarin for to lie in, then say *gǎnkuài* again

Before you move on

What does gǎnkuài mean? ("Quickly; hurry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

Day and Night

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the daytime, the night, the middle of the night, waking up and what I usually do.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can talk about the daytime, the night, the middle of the night, waking up and what I usually do.*

146.1 白天 (báitiān) — daytime

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lie in, then the Mandarin for hurry.

You'll want to know: 白天

白天 — *báitiān* — "daytime".

> 白天这儿很吵 *báitiān zhèr hěn chǎo* — It's noisy here in the daytime.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

白天 (*báitiān*) is built from 白 'white' and 天 'day, sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *baek* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the white, light part of the day.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: báitiān*
- *Say it: báitiān*, once more
- *Say it: báitiān zhèr hěn chǎo* — It's noisy here in the daytime.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lie in, then the Mandarin for hurry, then say *báitiān* again

Before you move on

What does 白天 mean? ("Daytime".) Say it once more.

146.2 yèli — at night

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hurry, then the Mandarin for daytime.

You'll want to know: yèli

yèli — "at night".

yèli hěn lěng — It's cold at night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yèli is built from *yè* 'night' and 里 'inside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yaeH* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'dusk' and 'a time to rest'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: yèli*
- *Say it: yèli*, once more

- *Say it: yèli hěn lěng* — It's cold at night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hurry, then the Mandarin for daytime, then say *yèli* again

Before you move on

What does yèli mean? ("At night".) Say it once more.

146.3 bànyè — the middle of the night

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for daytime, then the Mandarin for at night.

You'll want to know: bànyè

bànyè — "the middle of the night".

wǒ bànyè è le — I got hungry in the middle of the night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bànyè is built from 半 'half' and *yè* 'night', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *panH* and *yaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: bànyè*
- *Say it: bànyè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bànyè è le* — I got hungry in the middle of the night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for daytime, then the Mandarin for at night, then say *bànyè* again

Before you move on

What does bànyè mean? ("The middle of the night".) Say it once more.

146.4 xǐng — to wake up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at night, then the Mandarin for the middle of the night.

You'll want to know: xǐng

xǐng — "to wake up".

wǒ bànyè xǐng le yīnwèi wàibian hěn chǎo — I woke up in the middle of the night because it was noisy outside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐng is inherited from Middle Chinese *sengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'drunkenness passing off', that is, sobering up. Waking from sleep is not given there, so how the word came to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐng*
- *Say it: xǐng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bànyè xǐng le yīnwèi wàibian hěn chǎo* — I woke up in the middle of the night because it was noisy outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at night, then the Mandarin for the middle of the night, then say *xǐng* again

Before you move on

What does xǐng mean? ("To wake up".) Say it once more.

146.5 píngshí — usually; ordinarily

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the middle of the night, then the Mandarin for to wake up.

You'll want to know: píngshí

píngshí — "usually; ordinarily".

wǒ píngshí qī diǎn qǐchuáng — I usually get up at seven.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píngshí is built from *píng* 'level, even' and 时 'time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaeng* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the level, ordinary times.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: píngshí*
- *Say it: píngshí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ píngshí qī diǎn qǐchuáng* — I usually get up at seven.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the middle of the night, then the Mandarin for to wake up, then say *píngshí* again

Before you move on

What does píngshí mean? ("Usually; ordinarily".) Say it once more.

146.6 Looking back: from Travel and Fun to Day and Night

Say the Mandarin for to travel and a game.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to travel, a game, to stroll the shops, to take a walk, to go fishing
- to mop the floor, rubbish, to dry in the sun, to sort out, to water the plants
- second (of time), minute (a length of time), to be short of, punctual, a long while
- important, easy, simple, special, to find (that)
- a reason, to run behind schedule, alarm clock, to lie in, hurry
- daytime, at night, the middle of the night, to wake up, ordinarily

Before you move on

To travel? (*lǚyóu.*) A game? (*yóuxì.*) To stroll the shops? (*guàngjiē.*) To take a walk? (*sànbù.*) To go fishing? (*diàoyú.*) To mop the floor? (*tuōdì.*) Rubbish? (*lājī.*) To dry in the sun? (*shài.*) To sort out? (*zhěnglǐ.*) To water the plants? (*jiāohuā.*) Second (of time)? (*miǎo.*) Minute (a length of time)? (*fēnzhōng.*) To be short of? (*chà.*) Punctual? (*zhǔnshí.*) A long while? (半天, *bàntiān.*) Important? (重要, *zhòngyào.*) Easy? (*róngyì.*) Simple? (*jiǎndān.*) Special? (*tèbié.*) To find (that)? (*juéde.*) A reason? (*yuányīn.*) To run behind schedule? (晚点, *wǎndiǎn.*) Alarm clock? (*nàozhōng.*) To lie in? (*shuì lǎnjiào.*) Hurry? (*gǎnkuài.*) Daytime? (白天, *báitiān.*) At night? (*yèli.*) The middle of the night? (*bànyè.*) To wake up? (*xǐng.*) Ordinarily? (*píngshí.*)

146.7 Day and Night — once more

Say the Mandarin for daytime and at night.

Your turn

- *Say it:* daytime, at night, the middle of the night, to wake up, ordinarily

Before you move on

Daytime? (白天, *báitiān.*) At night? (*yèli.*) The middle of the night? (*bànyè.*) To wake up? (*xǐng.*) Ordinarily? (*píngshí.*)

Chapter 147

It Might Rain

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what will probably happen, and what the weather will do.
>
> *Saying what will happen with* 会*, maybe and certainly, the day after tomorrow and the weather forecast, built on one new written character:* 后.

147.1 后天 (hòutiān) — the day after tomorrow

A new chapter, and it opens with a day that has not come yet.

- *Recall:* say *píngshí*, usually — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 明天 — *míngtiān*, tomorrow — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *hòu*, after; behind — **R3**

You'll want to know: 后天

后天 — *hòutiān* — "the day after tomorrow".

> 后天我们去 *hòutiān wǒmen qù* — We're going the day after tomorrow.
>
> 今天 明天 后天 *jīntiān, míngtiān, hòutiān* — today, tomorrow, the day after

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. It is the *hòu* you already say for behind and after.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

后天 (*hòutiān*) is built from 后 'after' and 天 'day'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun lists *huwX* under the traditional form of the character and glosses it 'before and after'; it glosses *then* 'the heavens above', so 'day' is assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

后天 takes its place in the row of days you already say: *zuótiān*, 今天, 明天, 后天.
Like the others it goes early in the sentence, before the verb: 后天我们去 *hòutiān wǒmen qù*.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòutiān*
- *Say it: hòutiān*, once more
- *Say it:* 后天我们去 — *hòutiān wǒmen qù* — We're going the day after tomorrow.
- *Say it:* 今天 明天 后天 — *jīntiān, míngtiān, hòutiān* — today, tomorrow, the day after
- *Recall:* say *píngshí*, then *hòutiān* again

Before you move on

What does 后天 mean? ("The day after tomorrow".) And the day before it? (明天.)

147.2 后 — a three-stroke frame, then 口

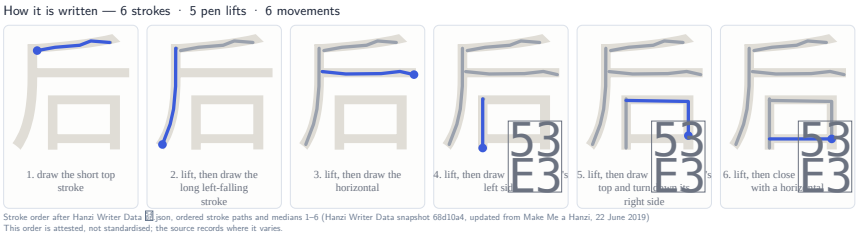
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *hòutiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 天

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *tiān*

Script — a three-stroke frame, then 口



How 后 is written, stroke by stroke

后

Two pieces, and the second you already write.

The frame, three strokes: a short left-falling stroke along the top, from right to left; a long left-falling stroke down the left side, curving out to the lower left; then a horizontal across the middle, from the long stroke to the right.

口, three strokes, under that horizontal, on the right: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the bottom bar.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 后, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 后? (**Six.**) Which stroke comes first? (**The short one along the top.**) Which character you write sits inside

the frame? (口.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 后, pinned stroke paths and medians.

147.3 明天会下雨 — 会 for what will happen

A word you already know does a second job in this lesson.

- *Read it:* 后天, aloud — *hòutiān*
- *Recall:* say 我会开车 — *wǒ huì kāichē*, I can drive
- *Recall:* say 下雨 — *xiàyǔ*, to rain

Grammar Lens: 会 before a verb, for what is going to happen

会 before a verb can say what will probably happen, or what someone will do.

明天会下雨 *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ* — It'll rain tomorrow. 后天不会下雨 *hòutiān bú huì xiàyǔ* — It won't rain the day after tomorrow.

不 before the fall of 会 is *bú*, as in *bú qù*.
You met 会 as *can*, for something learned: 我会开车. It is the same character in a different use. The rain has learned nothing, so 明天会下雨 is a forecast, not a skill; a time word in front usually tells you which one you hear.
You have said the future without 会 for a long time: 明天我们去 *míngtiān wǒmen qù* needs no extra word. 会 adds a forecast, what you expect to happen:

明天我会去 *míngtiān wǒ huì qù* — I'll go tomorrow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 明天会下雨 — *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ* — It'll rain tomorrow.
- 后天不会下雨 — *hòutiān bú huì xiàyǔ* — It won't rain the day after tomorrow.

- 明天我会去 — *míngtiān wǒ huì qù* — I'll go tomorrow.
- 我会开车 — *wǒ huì kāichē* — I can drive: the other 会.

Before you move on

What does 会 add to 明天会下雨? (**A forecast: it will rain.**) How do you say it won't? (不会, said *bú huì*.) What else can 会 mean? (**Can, for a skill:** 我会开车.)

147.4 kěnéng — maybe; possibly

Before the new one: read the last lesson's sentence, then a word that shares a sound with this one.

- *Read it:* 明天会下雨, aloud — *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ*
- *Recall:* say *kěyǐ*, may — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: kěnéng

kěnéng — "maybe; possibly".

tā kěnéng bù lái — He may not come.

míngtiān kěnéng huì xiàyǔ — It might rain tomorrow.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kěnéng is built from kě 'may', the kě of *kěyǐ*, and 能 'can', the 能 you write. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *nong* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to permit' and 'skilled'. 'Maybe' is the pair's own sense, which neither gloss gives.

What you've built

kěnéng goes before the verb, or before 会: *kěnéng huì xiàyǔ*, it might rain.
With 会 alone the forecast sounds sure; with *kěnéng* in front it is only a chance.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěnéng*
- *Say it: kěnéng*, once more
- *Say it: tā kěnéng bù lái* — He may not come.
- *Say it: míngtiān kěnéng huì xiàyǔ* — It might rain tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say *kěyǐ*, then *kěnéng*, and hear the same kě

Before you move on

What does *kěnéng* mean? ("Maybe; possibly".) Where does it go? (**Before the verb, or before 会.**)

147.5 yídìng — certainly; definitely

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then 一 with its rising tone.

- *Recall:* say *kěnéng*, maybe — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 一个 — *yí ge*, one of them, with 一 rising — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: yídìng

yídìng — "certainly; definitely".

tā yídìng huì lái — He'll definitely come.

一 rises before the fall of dìng: *yídìng*, as in *yí ge*.
Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yídìng is built from 一 'one' and dìng 'settled'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *dengH* glossed 'calm; settled'. 'Certainly' is the pair's own sense, not the gloss's.

What you've built

kěnéng and *yídìng* take the same place, before 会 or the verb: a chance, then a certainty.

- *tā kěnéng huì lái* — he may come.
- *tā yídìng huì lái* — he will, for sure.

Your turn

- *Say it: yídìng*
- *Say it: yídìng*, once more
- *Say it: tā yídìng huì lái* — He'll definitely come.
- *Say it: wǒ yídìng qù* — I'll be there, for sure.
- *Recall:* say *kěnéng*, then *yídìng*: a chance, then a certainty

Before you move on

What does *yídìng* mean? ("Certainly; definitely".) What does 一 do before the fall of dìng? (**It rises: *yí***.)

147.6 tiānqì yùbào — weather forecast

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the weather itself.

- *Recall:* say *yídìng*, certainly — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 天气 — *tiānqì*, the weather — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: tiānqì yùbào

tiānqì yùbào — "weather forecast".

tiānqì yùbào shuō míngtiān huì xiàyǔ — The forecast says it'll rain tomorrow.

Its last two characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiānqì yùbào is built from 天气 'weather' and yùbào. yùbào is built from yù and bào, inherited from Middle Chinese *yoH* and *pawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'beforehand' and 'to report'. A report given beforehand is the plain reading of the two; 'forecast' for the whole is the modern compound's own sense.

What you've built

tiānqì yùbào shuō …, the forecast says, and then the forecast itself, with 会:

> *tiānqì yùbào shuō hòutiān bú huì xiàyǔ* — The forecast says it won't rain the day after tomorrow.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānqì yùbào*
- *Say it: tiānqì yùbào*, once more
- *Say it: tiānqì yùbào shuō míngtiān huì xiàyǔ* — The forecast says it'll rain tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say 天气, then *tiānqì yùbào*

Before you move on

What does *tiānqì yùbào* mean? ("Weather forecast".) What does the forecast say, with 会? (*tiānqì yùbào shuō míngtiān huì xiàyǔ*.)

147.7 明天会下雨吗 — 后天不会

The chapter closes here, with two people planning around the rain.

- *Recall:* say *tiānqì yùbào*, the weather forecast — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *yídìng*, certainly — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *kěnéng*, maybe — **R2**

The exchange

A: 明天会下雨吗

míngtiān huì xiàyǔ ma — Will it rain tomorrow?

B: *huì, tiānqì yùbào shuō huì xiàyǔ* — It will. The forecast says so.

A: 后天呢

hòutiān ne — And the day after?

B: 后天不会

hòutiān bú huì — Not the day after.

A: 我们后天去

wǒmen hòutiān qù — Then we'll go the day after tomorrow.

B: 他会来吗

tā huì lái ma — Will he come?

A: *tā kěnéng bù lái* — He may not.

B: *wǒ yídìng lái* — I'll come, for sure.

会 answers a question about 会 on its own: *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ ma?* — *huì*. The answer drops everything else, as 是 and 有 do.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — a forecast, a chance, a certainty

Three ways to talk about what is coming, all before the verb:

- 明天会下雨 *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ* — it will rain tomorrow.
- *míngtiān kěnéng huì xiàyǔ* — it might.

- *tā yídìng huì lái* — he certainly will come.

Listen. *Hòutiān huì xiàyǔ ma?*
Speak. Say what the weather will do tomorrow, then what you will do the day after.
Write it: 后天 — the frame first, then 口, then 天

Your turn

- *Say it:* 明天会下雨吗 — *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ ma* — Will it rain tomorrow?
- *Say it:* 后天不会 — *hòutiān bú huì* — Not the day after.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 明天会下雨

Before you move on

Say it will rain tomorrow. (明天会下雨.) Say it won't rain the day after. (后天不会下雨.) Say he may not come. (*tā kěnéng bù lái.*)

Chapter 148

Next Month

Modes: **voice** (7) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I am going to do next week and next month.
>
> *Saying what you are going to do with* 要 *and dǎsuàn, next week, next month and last month, and what is about to happen with* 要…了*, built on one new written character:* 月*.*

148.1 下个月 (xià ge yuè) — next month

A new chapter, and it opens a little further ahead than tomorrow.

- *Recall:* say 明天会下雨吗 — *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ ma*, and answer it — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *tiānqì yùbào*, the weather forecast — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *yuè*, a month — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 明年 — *míngnián*, next year — **R3**

You'll want to know: 下个月

下个月 — *xià ge yuè* — "next month".

> 下个月我们去 *xià ge yuè wǒmen qù* — We're going next month.

The next lesson puts the last character in your hand. It is the *yuè* you already say for a month.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

下个月 (*xià ge yuè*) is built from 下 'below; after', 个, the measure word, and 月 'month'. All three are inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX*, *kaH* and *ngjwot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun glosses *haeX* with, among other things, 'after' and 'the bottom', and quotes an old saying about the moon under *ngjwot*; 'next' in a row of months is assumed from 'after', not quoted.

What you've built

下 here is the month after this one. Like 明天 and 后天, 下个月 goes early in the sentence: before the verb, or before the person.
明年 says next year with 明; the month and the week take 下.

Your turn

- *Say it: xià ge yuè*
- *Say it: xià ge yuè*, once more
- *Say it:* 下个月我们去 — *xià ge yuè wǒmen qù* — We're going next month.
- *Say it:* 明年 — *míngnián* — next year
- *Recall:* say *yuè*, then *xià ge yuè*

Before you move on

What does 下个月 mean? ("Next month".) And next year? (明年.)

148.2 月 — the moon piece, standing on its own

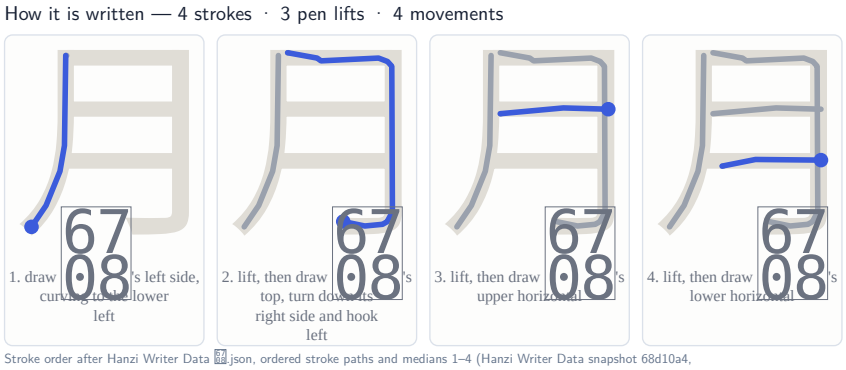
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xià ge yuè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  明 期 前 能

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *míng*, *qī*, *qián*, *néng*

Script — the moon piece, standing on its own



How 月 is written, stroke by stroke

月

Nothing in it is new. You have written it four times already: on the right of 明 and of 期, under the top of 前, and on the left of 能. Now it stands alone, a little taller.

A left-falling stroke down the left side, curving out to the lower left.

The hooked frame: a horizontal across the top that turns down the right side and hooks to the left at its foot.

Two inner bars, the upper one first, each from the left side across to the right.

1 + 1 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 月, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 月? (**Four**.) Where have you written it before? (**In 明, 期, 前 and 能**.) Which stroke goes in last? (**The lower inner bar**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 月, pinned stroke paths and medians.

148.3 火车要开了 — 要 for what is coming

A word you know, before a verb this time.

- *Read it:* 下个月, aloud — *xià ge yuè*
- *Recall:* say 我要水 — *wǒ yào shuǐ*, I want some water
- *Recall:* say 火车 — *huǒchē*, a train

Grammar Lens: 要 before a verb, for what is coming

要 before a thing says what you want. 要 before a verb says what you are going to do, and with 了 at the end, what is about to happen.

我要水 *wǒ yào shuǐ* — I want some water. 下个月我要去中国 *xià ge yuè wǒ yào qù Zhōngguó* — Next month I'm going to China.

The test is the word after 要: a thing, and you want it; a verb, and you are going to do it.

火车要开了 *huǒchē yào kāi le* — The train is about to leave.

The 了 at the end is the 了 of a change, as in 我是大学生了: the moment is nearly here. For any second now, put *kuài* in front: *huǒchē kuàiyào kāi le*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 火车要开了 — *huǒchē yào kāi le* — The train is about to leave.
- 下个月我要去中国 — *xià ge yuè wǒ yào qù Zhōngguó* — Next month I'm going to China.
- 我要水 — *wǒ yào shuǐ* — I want some water.
- *huǒchē kuàiyào kāi le* — the train is leaving any second

Before you move on

What does 要 mean before a thing? (**Want**.) Before a verb? (**Going to**.) What does 了 add to 火车要开了? (**It is about to happen**.)

148.4 下星期 (xià xīngqī) — next week

Before the new one: read the last lesson's sentence, then two words for the week.

- *Read it:* 火车要开了, aloud — *huǒchē yào kāi le*
- *Recall:* say 星期天 — *xīngqītiān*, Sunday — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *zhōumò*, the weekend — **R3**

You'll want to know: 下星期

下星期 — *xià xīngqī* — "next week".

下星期我们去看书 *xià xīngqī wǒmen qù kàn shū* — Next week we're going to go and read.

下星期我要开车去 *xià xīngqī wǒ yào kāichē qù* — Next week I'm going to drive there.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

下星期 (*xià xīngqī*) is built from 下 'after' and 星期 'week'. 星 and 期 are inherited from Middle Chinese, *seng* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the stars' and 'a meeting; a limit'. The regular sound change from *gi* would give a second tone, qí; why the week says qī is not settled.

What you've built

下星期 takes no 个; 下个月 does. Both go early in the sentence, and both pair with 要 before a verb:

下个月我要去中国 *xià ge yuè wǒ yào qù Zhōngguó* — Next month I'm going to China.

Your turn

- *Say it: xià xīngqī*
- *Say it: xià xīngqī*, once more
- *Say it:* 下星期我要开车去 — *xià xīngqī wǒ yào kāichē qù* — Next week I'm going to drive there.
- *Recall:* say *zhōumò*, then *xià xīngqī*

Before you move on

What does 下星期 mean? ("Next week".) Which takes 个, the week or the month? (**The month:** 下个月.)

148.5 上个月 (shàng ge yuè) — last month

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then 了 after a verb.

- *Recall:* say 下星期 — *xià xīngqī*, next week — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 我看了书 — *wǒ kàn le shū*, I read the book — **R4**, recognition at distance

You'll want to know: 上个月

上个月 — *shàng ge yuè* — "last month".

上个月我去了中国 *shàng ge yuè wǒ qù le Zhōngguó* — Last month I went to China.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上个月 (*shàng ge yuè*) is built from 上 'above; before', 个 and 月. 上 is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun glosses this reading 'ruler', so 'above', and 'last' in a row of months, are assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

上 and 下 point through time as through a list read from the top: the month above is the one before, the month below the one after. 上个月 looks back, so it takes 了 when you say what happened: 上个月, 我, 去了, 中国.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàng ge yuè*
- *Say it: shàng ge yuè*, once more
- *Say it:* 上个月我去了中国 — *shàng ge yuè wǒ qù le Zhōngguó* — Last month I went to China.
- *Say it:* 下个月我要去中国 — *xià ge yuè wǒ yào qù Zhōngguó* — Next month I'm going to China.
- *Recall:* say *xià xīngqī*, then *shàng ge yuè*

Before you move on

What does 上个月 mean? ("Last month".) And next month? (下个月.)

148.6 dǎsuàn — to plan to; to intend

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a verb this one is built on.

- *Recall:* say 上个月 — *shàng ge yuè*, last month — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *suàn*, to work out — **R2**, a few chapters back

You'll want to know: dǎsuàn

dǎsuàn — "to plan to; to intend".

wǒ dǎsuàn xià ge yuè qù Běijīng — I'm planning to go to Beijing next month.

nǐ dǎsuàn zuò shénme — What are you planning to do?

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎsuàn is built from 打, the 打 of 打电话, and *suàn* 'to work out', the word you know. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *swanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to strike' and 'the number of things'. Neither dǎ nor suàn is the sound those readings would regularly give, and how striking and counting came to mean planning is not settled.

What you've built

dǎsuàn comes before a verb, as 要 does: *wǒ dǎsuàn qù*, I plan to go. 要 says it is going to happen; *dǎsuàn* says it is your plan, and a plan can change.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎsuàn*
- *Say it: dǎsuàn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ dǎsuàn zuò shénme* — What are you planning to do?
- *Say it: wǒ dǎsuàn xià ge yuè qù Běijīng* — I'm planning to go to Beijing next month.
- *Recall:* say *suàn*, then *dǎsuàn*

Before you move on

What does *dǎsuàn* mean? ("To plan to; to intend".) What comes after it? (**A verb: *dǎsuàn qù*.**)

148.7 jiānglái — in the future; some day

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a word about growing up.

- *Recall:* say *dǎsuàn*, to plan to — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 长大 — *zhǎngdà*, to grow up — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: jiānglái

jiānglái — "in the future; some day".

jiānglái wǒ xiǎng zuò lǎoshī — Some day I'd like to be a teacher.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiānglái is built from jiāng and 来 'to come'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjang* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to send off; to go' and 'to arrive'. 'The time to come' is the pair's own sense, assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

jiānglái reaches further than 下个月 or 明年: not a date, but the years ahead.
It goes early, before the person, as the other time words do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiānglái*
- *Say it: jiānglái*, once more
- *Say it: jiānglái wǒ xiǎng zuò lǎoshī* — Some day I'd like to be a teacher.
- *Recall:* say *zhǎngdà*, then *jiānglái*

Before you move on

What does *jiānglái* mean? ("In the future; some day".) Is it a date? (**No: the years ahead**.)

148.8 下个月我要去中国

The chapter closes here, with two people on a platform, trading plans.

- *Recall:* say *jiānglái*, in the future — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *dǎsuàn*, to plan to — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 上个月 — *shàng ge yuè*, last month — **R2**

The exchange

A: 下星期你要做什么

xià xīngqī nǐ yào zuò shénme — What are you going to do next week?

B: 下星期我要开车去大学

xià xīngqī wǒ yào kāichē qù dàxué — Next week I'm going to drive to the university.

A: 下个月呢

xià ge yuè ne — And next month?

B: 下个月我要去中国

xià ge yuè wǒ yào qù Zhōngguó — Next month I'm going to China.

A: 上个月你也去了中国吗

shàng ge yuè nǐ yě qù le Zhōngguó ma — Did you go to China last month too?

B: 没有 上个月我在家

méiyǒu, shàng ge yuè wǒ zài jiā — No, last month I was at home.

A: *jiānglái nǐ dǎsuàn zuò shénme* — What do you plan to do in the future?

B: *wǒ xiǎng zuò lǎoshī* — I'd like to be a teacher.

要 before each verb says what is coming; 上个月 takes 了 because it is over. *méiyǒu* answers the question about the past, as 没 reports what did not happen.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — next week, next month, some day

Time words go first; 要 or *dǎsuàn* goes before the verb:

- 下星期我要开车去 *xià xīngqī wǒ yào kāichē qù* — next week I'm going to drive.
- 下个月我要去中国 *xià ge yuè wǒ yào qù Zhōngguó* — next month I'm going to China.
- *jiānglái wǒ xiǎng zuò lǎoshī* — some day I'd like to teach.

Listen. *Xià ge yuè nǐ yào qù nǎr?*
Speak. Say what you are going to do next week, then next month.
Write it: 下个月 — 月 is the moon piece of 明, standing alone

Your turn

- *Say it:* 下星期你要做什么 — *xià xīngqī nǐ yào zuò shénme* — What are you going to do next week?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 下个月我要去中国

Before you move on

Say next month. (下个月.) Say you are going to China. (我要去中国.) Say the train is about to leave. (火车要开了.) Say what you plan to do. (*wǒ dǎsuàn* ….)

Chapter 149

Right Now

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what someone is doing right now.
>
> *Saying what is going on right now with* 在 *and* 正在 *before a verb, two things at once with* 一边 *…* 一边*, and a happy coincidence with* 正好*, built on one new written character:* 正*.*

149.1 正在 (zhèngzài) — in the middle of (doing)

A new chapter, and it opens on what is going on at this moment.

- *Recall:* say 下个月我要去中国 — *xià ge yuè wǒ yào qù Zhōngguó* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *jiānglái*, in the future — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 我在家 — *wǒ zài jiā*, I'm at home — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 正在

正在 — *zhèngzài* — "in the middle of (doing)".

> 我正在吃饭 *wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn* — I'm eating right now.
>
> 他正在看书 *tā zhèngzài kàn shū* — He's reading at the moment.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

正在 (*zhèngzài*) is built from 正 'exactly' and 在 'at', the 在 you write. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengH* and *dzojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'exactly fitting; proper' and 'to dwell; to exist'. The use before a verb, in the middle of doing it, is the modern one and is assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

正在 goes before the verb: 我, 正在, 吃饭.
在 without 正 can do the same job before a verb; that comes two lessons on.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngzài*
- *Say it: zhèngzài*, once more
- *Say it:* 我正在吃饭 — *wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn* — I'm eating right now.
- *Say it:* 他正在看书 — *tā zhèngzài kàn shū* — He's reading at the moment.
- *Recall:* say 我在家, then 我正在吃饭

Before you move on

What does 正在 mean? ("In the middle of (doing)".) Where does it go? (**Before the verb**.)

149.2 正 — 一 on top, then the middle of 上 on a long bar

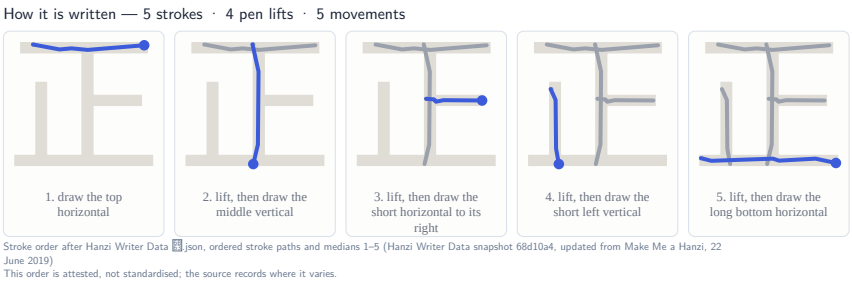
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhèngzài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  一 上

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yī*, *shàng*

Script — 一 on top, then the middle of 上 on a long bar



How 正 is written, stroke by stroke

正

一 on top, then four strokes, two of them shaped as in 上.

一, a bar across the top.

A vertical down the middle, from under the bar to the foot.

A short bar to its right, halfway down: with the vertical, the upper part of 上.

A short vertical on the left, from the height of that bar down to the foot.

The long bar along the foot, last, under everything.

1 + 4 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 正, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 正? (**Five**.) Which stroke is last? (**The long bar along the foot**.) Which character you write shares its middle? (上.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 正, pinned stroke paths and medians.

149.3 你在做什么 — 在 before a verb

在 again, and this time it comes before a verb.

- *Read it:* 正在, aloud — *zhèngzài*
- *Recall:* say 你呢 — *nǐ ne*, and you?

Grammar Lens: 在 before a place, 在 before a verb

在 before a place says where. 在 before a verb says what is going on right now.

他在家 *tā zài jiā* — He's at home. 他在看书 *tā zài kàn shū* — He's reading.

正在 says it more firmly, in the very middle of it: 我正在吃饭. 呢 at the end can round off either one:

他在看书呢 *tā zài kàn shū ne* — He's busy reading.

The negative is 没在, since 没 reports what is not going on:

我没在看书 *wǒ méi zài kàn shū* — I'm not reading.

你在做什么 *nǐ zài zuò shénme* — What are you doing?

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 你在做什么 — *nǐ zài zuò shénme* — What are you doing?
- 我在看书 — *wǒ zài kàn shū* — I'm reading.
- 他在看书呢 — *tā zài kàn shū ne* — He's busy reading.
- 我没在看书 — *wǒ méi zài kàn shū* — I'm not reading.

Before you move on

What does 在 say before a place? (**Where**.) Before a verb? (**What is going on now**.) How do you say you are not reading? (我没在看

书.)

149.4 正好 (zhènghǎo) — exactly right; as it happens

Before the new one: read the last lesson's question, then the word for good.

- *Read it:* 你在做什么, aloud — *nǐ zài zuò shénme*
- *Recall:* say 好 — *hǎo*, good — **R4**, recognition at distance

You'll want to know: 正好

正好 — *zhènghǎo* — "exactly right; as it happens".

正好 我也要去 *zhènghǎo, wǒ yě yào qù* — As it happens, I'm going too.

这个正好 *zhège zhènghǎo* — This one is exactly right.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

正好 (*zhènghǎo*) is built from 正 'exactly' and 好 'good': exactly right. 好 is inherited from Middle Chinese *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'good; fine'.

What you've built

正好 can open a sentence, a happy coincidence: 正好, 我也要去.
Or it can follow a thing, which then fits: 这个正好.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhènghǎo*
- *Say it: zhènghǎo*, once more
- *Say it:* 正好 我也要去 — *zhènghǎo, wǒ yě yào qù* — As it happens, I'm going too.
- *Say it:* 这个正好 — *zhège zhènghǎo* — This one is exactly right.

- *Recall:* say 你在做什么, then 正好

Before you move on

What does 正好 mean? ("Exactly right; as it happens".) Say that, as it happens, you are going too. (正好 我也要去.)

149.5 一边 (yìbiān) — at the same time

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a word with the same ending.

- *Recall:* say 正好 — *zhènghǎo*, as it happens — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *pángbiān*, beside — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 一边

一边 — *yìbiān* — "at the same time", said twice, before two verbs; also "one side".

他一边吃饭一边看书 *tā yìbiān chī fàn yìbiān kàn shū* — He reads while he eats.

一 falls before the level tone of biān: *yìbiān*, as in *yì tiān*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一边 (*yìbiān*) is built from 一 'one' and 边 'side', the 边 you write. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *pen* glossed 'an edge; a border'.

What you've built

Said twice, each straight before its own verb, 一边 … 一边 … puts two actions side by side: 一边吃饭, 一边看书.
The person is said once, at the front: 他一边吃饭一边看书.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìbiān*
- *Say it: yìbiān*, once more
- *Say it:* 他一边吃饭一边看书 — *tā yìbiān chī fàn yìbiān kàn shū* — He reads while he eats.
- *Say it: wǒ yìbiān hē chá yìbiān shuō huà* — I talk while I drink my tea.
- *Recall:* say *pángbiān*, then *yìbiān*

Before you move on

What does 一边 … 一边 do? (**Puts two actions at the same time**.) Where does each 一边 go? (**Straight before its verb**.)

149.6 我正在吃饭

The chapter closes here, with a phone call about what everyone is doing.

- *Recall:* say 一边吃饭一边看书 — *yìbiān chī fàn yìbiān kàn shū* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 正好 — *zhènghǎo* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *bànyè*, the middle of the night — **R2**, the chapter on night

The exchange

A: 你在做什么

nǐ zài zuò shénme — What are you doing?

B: 我正在吃饭 你呢

wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn, nǐ ne — I'm eating. And you?

A: 我在看书

wǒ zài kàn shū — I'm reading.

B: 你妈妈呢

nǐ māma ne — And your mum?

A: 妈妈在做饭

māma zài zuò fàn — She's cooking.

B: *nǐ bàba ne* — And your dad?

A: 他没在家 他在开车

tā méi zài jiā, tā zài kāichē — He isn't home. He's driving.

B: 我一边吃饭一边打电话

wǒ yìbiān chī fàn yìbiān dǎ diànhuà — I'm eating and on the phone at once.

A: 正好 我也在吃饭

zhènghǎo, wǒ yě zài chī fàn — As it happens, I'm eating too.

Every answer keeps 在 before its verb. 他没在家 is 在 before a place, at home; 他在开车 is 在 before a verb, driving.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — now, and two things at once

在 or 正在 before the verb says what is going on now:

- 我正在吃饭 *wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn* — I'm eating right now.
- 他在开车 *tā zài kāichē* — he's driving.
- 白天我在看书 *báitiān wǒ zài kàn shū* — in the daytime I'm reading.

- *bànyè tā zhèngzài shuìjiào* — in the middle of the night he's asleep.

Listen. *Nǐ zài zuò shénme ne?*
Speak. Say what you are doing now, then what somebody at home is doing.
Write it: 正在 — 一, then the middle of 上, then the long bar

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你在做什么 — *nǐ zài zuò shénme* — What are you doing?
- *Say it:* 我正在吃饭 你呢 — *wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn, nǐ ne* — I'm eating. And you?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我正在吃饭

Before you move on

Ask what someone is doing. (你在做什么.) Say you are eating right now. (我正在吃饭.) Say he reads while he eats. (他一边吃饭一边看书.)

Chapter 150

Have You Ever Been?

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask whether someone has ever done something, and answer.
>
> *Asking whether someone has ever done something with* 过 *after the verb, and telling what came next with* 后来 *and ránhòu, built on one new written character:* 过.

150.1 过去 (guòqù) — in the past; to go over

A new chapter, and it opens on time that has already gone by.

- *Recall:* say 我正在吃饭 — *wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 一边 — *yìbiān*, at the same time — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 以前 — *yǐqián*, before — **R2**, a few chapters back

You'll want to know: 过去

过去 — *guòqù* — "in the past; to go over (there)".

> 过去 我家在大学里边 *guòqù, wǒ jiā zài dàxué lǐbian* — In the past, our home was on the university grounds.

> 我过去 *wǒ guòqù* — I'll go over there.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. It is the guò of *guònián* and *nánguò*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

过去 (*guòqù*) is built from 过 'to pass' and 去 'to go'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaH* and *khjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to go beyond; to exceed' and 'to leave'. 'The past', time that has gone by, is the pair's own sense.

What you've built

过去 and 以前 both look back. 以前 is before some point; 过去 is the past at large, set against now, *xiànzài*.
As a verb, 过去 is going over there, away from the speaker.

Your turn

- *Say it: guòqù*
- *Say it: guòqù*, once more
- *Say it:* 过去 我家在大学里边 — *guòqù, wǒ jiā zài dàxué lǐbian* — In the past, our home was on the university grounds.
- *Say it:* 我过去 — *wǒ guòqù* — I'll go over there.
- *Recall:* say 以前, then 过去

Before you move on

What does 过去 mean? ("In the past; to go over".) And now? (*xiànzài*.)

150.2 过 — 寸, then the walking piece last

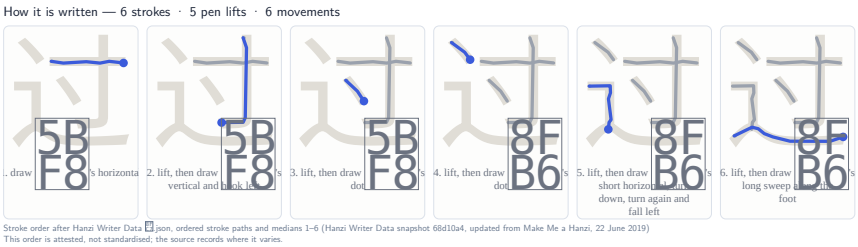
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *guòqù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  对 时 这 进

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *duì*, *shí*, *zhè*, *jìn*

Script — 寸, then the walking piece last



How 过 *is written, stroke by stroke*

过

Two pieces you own, in the order you know from 这.

寸**, three strokes**, on the upper right: the bar, the vertical that hooks to the left at its foot, then the dot. It is the right half of 对 and of 时.

辶**, three strokes**, last: the dot at the upper left; the short stroke that turns down, turns again and falls to the left in one movement; then the long base, sweeping out to the right under 寸.

3 + 3 = six. The walking piece goes in last, as in 这 and 进, though it sits under everything.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 过, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 过? (**Six.**) Which piece first? (寸.) Which character you write puts the walking piece last in the same way? (**这, and 进.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 过, pinned stroke paths and medians.

150.3 你去过中国吗 — 过 for what you have done

The character you have written turns up again, light, straight after a verb.

- *Read it:* 过去, aloud — *guòqù*
- *Recall:* say 我去了中国 — *wǒ qù le Zhōngguó*, I went to China
- *Recall:* say 我没去 — *wǒ méi qù*, I didn't go

Grammar Lens: 了 says it happened; 过 says it has happened at least once

过 straight after a verb says this has happened at least once, at some time. Here it is said light: *guo*.

你去过中国吗 *nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma* — Have you ever been to China? 我去过 *wǒ qù guo* — I have.

The negative keeps 过 and puts 没 in front; 不 has no place here, because the question is about what has happened:

我没去过 *wǒ méi qù guo* — I've not been.

Set it beside 了. 我去了中国 reports one trip; 我去过中国 says China is somewhere you have been, at some point in your life:

我去了中国 *wǒ qù le Zhōngguó* — I went to China. 我去过中国 *wǒ qù guo Zhōngguó* — I've been to China.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 你去过中国吗 — *nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma* — Have you ever been to China?
- 我去过 — *wǒ qù guo* — I have.
- 我没去过 — *wǒ méi qù guo* — I've not been.
- 你看过这本书吗 — *nǐ kàn guo zhè běn shū ma* — Have you read this book?

Before you move on

What does 过 after a verb say? (**It has happened at least once.**) Which negative goes with it? (没: 我没去过.) Which says one trip that happened, 了 or 过? (了.)

150.4 后来 (hòulái) — afterwards; later

Before the new one: read the last lesson's question, then the day you wrote 后 for.

- *Read it:* 你去过中国吗, aloud — *nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma*
- *Recall:* say 后天 — *hòutiān*, the day after tomorrow — **R2**, a few chapters back

You'll want to know: 后来

后来 — *hòulái* — "afterwards; later (in the past)".

后来我们去了大学 *hòulái wǒmen qù le dàxué* — Afterwards we went to the university.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

后来 (*hòulái*) is built from 后 'after' and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): what came after.

What you've built

后来 looks back: it follows something that already happened and says what came next. For what will come later, Mandarin says *yǐhòu*: *yí ge xiǎoshí yǐhòu*.
One more way to set a time in the past: *de shíhou* after a clause turns it into a when, the shíhou of *xiǎoshíhou*:

wǒ xiǎo de shíhou, wǒ jiā zài Zhōngguó, hòulái wǒmen lái zhèr le — When I was small my family lived in China; later we came here.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòuláì*
- *Say it: hòuláì*, once more
- *Say it:* 后来我们去了大学 — *hòuláì wǒmen qù le dàxué* — Afterwards we went to the university.
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎo de shíhou, wǒ jiā zài Zhōngguó* — When I was small my family lived in China.
- *Recall:* say 后天, then 后来, and hear the same hòu

Before you move on

What does 后来 mean? ("Afterwards; later, in the past".) And for later still to come? (*yǐhòu*.)

150.5 ránhòu — then; after that

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a word that ends the same way.

- *Recall:* say 后来 — *hòuláì*, afterwards — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *yǐhòu*, after — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: ránhòu

ránhòu — "then; after that".

wǒ xiān chī fàn, ránhòu kàn shū — First I eat, then I read.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ránhòu is built from rán 'so; thus' and 后 'after'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyen* and *huwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun glosses *nyen* as a particle, 'thus', and 'then' for the pair is assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

ránhòu joins two steps in order, the second after the first, now or in the past: *wǒ xiān chī fàn, ránhòu kàn shū.*
后来 only looks back at what happened next; *ránhòu* can plan tomorrow too: *míngtiān wǒ qù dàxué, ránhòu qù kàn shū.*

Your turn

- *Say it: ránhòu*
- *Say it: ránhòu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiān chī fàn, ránhòu kàn shū* — First I eat, then I read.
- *Recall:* say 后来, then *ránhòu*

Before you move on

What does *ránhòu* mean? ("Then; after that".) Which of the two can plan tomorrow, 后来 or *ránhòu*? (***ránhòu***.)

150.6 cónglái — ever; never once

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the answer to have you ever.

- *Recall:* say *ránhòu*, then — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 我没去过 — *wǒ méi qù guo*, I've not been — **R1**, this chapter

You'll want to know: cónglái

cónglái — "ever"; before 没, "never once".

wǒ cónglái méi qù guo — I've never once been there.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cónglái is built from cóng 'from' and 来 'to come': from then until now. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjowng* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *dzjowng* glossed 'to go to; to follow'. 'Ever' is the pair's own sense, not the gloss's.

What you've built

cónglái stands in front of 没 … 过 and makes it stronger: 我没去过, I've not been; *wǒ cónglái méi qù guo*, not once.
It needs 没 after it to say never; on its own it is rare.

Your turn

- *Say it: cónglái*
- *Say it: cónglái*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ cónglái méi qù guo* — I've never once been there.
- *Say it:* 我没去过 — *wǒ méi qù guo* — I've not been.
- *Recall:* say *ránhòu*, then *cónglái*

Before you move on

What does *cónglái méi* … 过 say? (**Never once**.) What does it strengthen? (我没去过.)

150.7 你去过吗 — 我没去过

The chapter closes here, with two people comparing where they have been.

- *Recall:* say *cónglái*, ever — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *ránhòu*, then — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 后来 — *hòulái*, afterwards — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你去过中国吗

nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma — Have you ever been to China?

B: 去过

qù guo — I have.

B: 过去我家在中国

guòqù wǒ jiā zài Zhōngguó — My family used to live there.

A: 后来呢

hòulái ne — And afterwards?

B: 后来我们来这儿了

hòulái wǒmen lái zhèr le — Afterwards we came here.

B: 你呢 你去过吗

nǐ ne, nǐ qù guo ma — And you? Have you been?

A: 我没去过

wǒ méi qù guo — I've not been.

B: 你开过车吗

nǐ kāi guo chē ma — Have you ever driven a car?

A: *wǒ cónglái méi kāi guo* — Never once.

B: *wǒ xiān qù Zhōngguó, ránhòu qù Běijīng* — I'll go to China first, then to Beijing.

去过 answers 你去过中国吗 on its own: the verb and 过, nothing else. The no is 没去过, with 过 kept.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — ever, and what came next

过 after a verb asks about a whole life; 后来 and *ránhòu* put events in order:

- 你去过中国吗 *nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma* — have you ever been to China?
- 我没去过 *wǒ méi qù guo* — I've not been.
- 后来我们来这儿了 *hòulái wǒmen lái zhèr le* — afterwards we came here.
- *wǒ xiān chī fàn, ránhòu kàn shū* — first I eat, then I read.

Listen. *Nǐ qù guo Běijīng ma?*
Speak. Say one place you have been, and one you have not.
Write it: 过 — the right half of 对 first, the walking piece last

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你去过中国吗 — *nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma* — Have you ever been to China?
- *Say it:* 我没去过 — *wǒ méi qù guo* — I've not been.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 你去过中国吗

Before you move on

Ask if someone has ever been to China. (你去过中国吗.) Say you have not. (我没去过.) Say what happened afterwards, with 后来. (后来我们来这儿了.)

Chapter 151

Seen and Understood

Modes: **voice** (7) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that I saw, heard, understood or finished something.
>
> *A verb and its result: seeing, learning how, understanding by ear and by eye, and finishing, each negated with* 没*, built on one new written character:* 到.

151.1 看到 (kàndào) — to see; to catch sight of

A new chapter, and it opens on a verb that reaches what it aims at.

- *Recall:* say 你去过吗 — *nǐ qù guo ma*, and answer it — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *cónglái*, ever — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 看见 — *kànjiàn*, to catch sight of — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *dào*, to arrive — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 看到

看到 — *kàndào* — "to see; to catch sight of".

> 我看到他了 *wǒ kàndào tā le* — I saw him.
>
> 我没看到 *wǒ méi kàndào* — I didn't spot it.

The next lesson puts the second character in your hand. It is the *dào* you already say for arriving.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

看到 (*kàndào*) is built from 看 'to look' and 到 'to arrive; to reach'. 看 is inherited from Middle Chinese *khanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the Guangyun lists beside a level-tone reading glossed 'to look'; 到 is inherited from *tawH*, glossed 'to arrive'.

What you've built

看 is the looking; 到 says the looking reached something.
看见, which you learned long ago as one word, is made the same way: 看, then 见.

Your turn

- *Say it: kàndào*
- *Say it: kàndào*, once more
- *Say it:* 我看到他了 — *wǒ kàndào tā le* — I saw him.
- *Say it:* 我没看到 — *wǒ méi kàndào* — I didn't spot it.
- *Recall:* say 看见, then 看到

Before you move on

What does 看到 mean? ("To see; to catch sight of".) Which word you know is made the same way? (看见.)

151.2 到 — 至 on the left, then the blade of 前

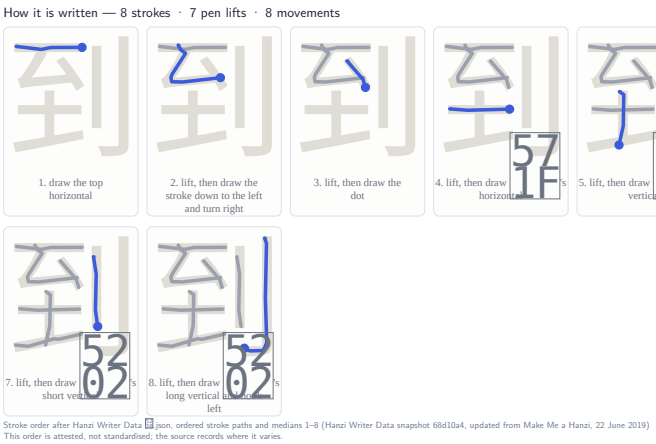
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kàndào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  在 前

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zài*, *qián*

Script — 至 on the left, then the blade of 前



How 到 *is written, stroke by stroke*

到

Two pieces, and both have parts you write.

至**, six strokes**, on the left: a bar across the top; a stroke that falls to the left and turns right; a dot at its end; then 土, as at the foot of 在: a short bar, a vertical through it, and the bottom bar, rising a little to the right.

刂**, two strokes**, on the right, as on the right of 前: a short vertical, then a long vertical that hooks to the left at its foot.

6 + 2 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 到, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 到? (**Eight**.) Which character you write ends on the same 土? (在.) And on the same two right-hand strokes? (前.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 到, pinned stroke paths and medians.

151.3 看到 — 没看到: a verb and its result

Two verbs in a row, and the second one says how it turned out.

- *Read it:* 看到, aloud — *kàndào*
- *Recall:* say 看见 — *kànjiàn*
- *Recall:* say 我没去 — *wǒ méi qù*, I didn't go

Grammar Lens: a verb, then what came of it

A second word straight after a verb can say how it turned out. 看 is looking; 看到 is looking that reached something.

我看了 没看到 *wǒ kàn le, méi kàndào* — I looked, but I didn't spot it.

The negative is 没, because the result did not come about:

我没看到他 *wǒ méi kàndào tā* — I didn't see him. 你看到了吗 *nǐ kàndào le ma* — Did you see it?

看见 is made the same way, 看 and its result 见. The next four lessons add four more pairs like these, each a verb and how it ended.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我看了 没看到 — *wǒ kàn le, méi kàndào* — I looked, but I didn't spot it.
- 你看到了吗 — *nǐ kàndào le ma* — Did you see it?
- 看到了 — *kàndào le* — Yes, I saw it.
- 我没看到他 — *wǒ méi kàndào tā* — I didn't see him.

Before you move on

What does the second word of 看到 say? (**How the looking turned out**.) Which negative goes in front? (**没:** 没看到.) Which old word is made the same way? (看见.)

151.4 学会 (xuéhuì) — to learn, and now be able to

Before the new one: read the last lesson's pair, then 会 as a skill.

- *Read it:* 看到 — 没看到, aloud — *kàndào*, *méi kàndào*
- *Recall:* say 我会开车 — *wǒ huì kāichē*, I can drive — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *xué*, to study — **R4**, recognition at distance

You'll want to know: 学会

学会 — *xuéhuì* — "to learn (and now be able to)".

我学会开车了 *wǒ xuéhuì kāichē le* — I've learned to drive.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

学会 (*xuéhuì*) is built from 学 'to study' and 会 'can'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *haewk* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to awaken to; to learn' and 'to come together'. 会 as 'can' is a later sense than that gloss, assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

学 is the studying; 会 is the result: now you can. With 了 at the end it is news: 我学会开车了.
Without the result, 我学开车 *wǒ xué kāichē* says only that you are studying it.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuéhuì*
- *Say it: xuéhuì*, once more
- *Say it:* 我学会开车了 — *wǒ xuéhuì kāichē le* — I've learned to drive.
- *Say it:* 我没学会 — *wǒ méi xuéhuì* — I haven't learned how.
- *Recall:* say 我会开车, then 我学会开车了

Before you move on

What does 学会 mean? ("To learn, and now be able to".) Which part is the result? (会.)

151.5 tīngdǒng — to understand what you hear

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the two verbs this one is made of.

- *Recall:* say 学会 — *xuéhuì* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *tīng*, to listen — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *dǒng*, to understand — **R3**

You'll want to know: tīngdǒng

tīngdǒng — "to understand (on hearing)".

wǒ tīngdǒng le — I understood what was said.

nǐ tīngdǒng le ma — Did you catch that?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tīngdǒng is built from *tīng* 'to listen' and *dǒng* 'to understand', the two verbs you know. The character for *tīng* is inherited from Middle Chinese *theng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to hear'. The character for *dǒng* has no reading in the Guangyun: no dictionary

we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

tīng is the listening; *dǒng* is the result. 没 says it did not come: *wǒ méi tīngdǒng*, I didn't catch it.
tīng alone is only listening; *tīngdǒng* is listening that worked.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīngdǒng*
- *Say it: tīngdǒng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ tīngdǒng le ma* — Did you catch that?
- *Say it: wǒ méi tīngdǒng* — I didn't catch it.
- *Recall:* say *tīng*, then *dǒng*, then *tīngdǒng*

Before you move on

What does *tīngdǒng* mean? ("To understand what you hear".) Say you didn't catch it. (*wǒ méi tīngdǒng.*)

151.6 kàndǒng — to understand what you read

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then reading a book.

- *Recall:* say *tīngdǒng*, to understand what you hear — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 看书 — *kàn shū*, to read — **R4**, recognition at distance

You'll want to know: kàndǒng

kàndǒng — "to understand (on reading or watching)".

zhè běn shū wǒ kàndǒng le — I understood this book.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kàndǒng is built from 看 'to look; to read' and *dǒng* 'to understand'. 看 is inherited from Middle Chinese *khanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the character for *dǒng* has no reading in the Guangyun, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

The thing can go first, as the topic: *zhè běn shū*, then who, then the verb and its result.
tīngdǒng for the ear, *kàndǒng* for the eye: one result, two ways in.

Your turn

- *Say it: kàndǒng*
- *Say it: kàndǒng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè běn shū wǒ kàndǒng le* — I understood this book.
- *Say it: nǐ kàndǒng le ma* — Did you follow it?
- *Recall:* say *tīngdǒng*, then *kàndǒng*

Before you move on

What does *kàndǒng* mean? ("To understand what you read or watch".) And by ear? (*tīngdǒng*.)

151.7 zuòwán — to finish (doing)

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the verb this one starts with.

- *Recall:* say *kàndǒng*, to understand what you read — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 做饭 — *zuò fàn*, to cook — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: zuòwán

zuòwán — "to finish (doing)".

wǒ zuòwán le — I've finished.

nǐ zuòwán le ma — Have you finished?

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuòwán is built from 做 'to do', the 做 you write, and wán 'to finish'. 做 has no reading in the Guangyun, so its history is not settled. wán is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'whole; complete'; the regular sound change from *hwan* would give huán, so why it is said wán is not settled.

What you've built

做 is the doing; wán is the result: it is done. 了 at the end makes it news: *wǒ zuòwán le.*
Not finished yet takes 没: *wǒ méi zuòwán.*

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòwán*
- *Say it: zuòwán*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuòwán le ma* — Have you finished?
- *Say it: wǒ zuòwán le* — I've finished.
- *Recall:* say 做饭, then *zuòwán*

Before you move on

What does *zuòwán* mean? ("To finish doing".) Say you haven't finished. (*wǒ méi zuòwán.*)

151.8 我看到他了

The chapter closes here, with two people checking on each other.

- *Recall:* say *zuòwán*, to finish — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *kàndǒng*, to understand what you read — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 学会 — *xuéhuì* — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你看到他了吗

nǐ kàndào tā le ma — Did you see him?

B: 看到了 他在那儿

kàndào le, tā zài nàr — I did. He's over there.

A: 他说什么

tā shuō shénme — What's he saying?

A: *nǐ tīngdǒng le ma* — Did you catch it?

B: *méi tīngdǒng, tā shuō de tài kuài le* — No. He talks too fast.

A: *nǐ zuòwán le ma* — Have you finished?

B: 没有 我在看书

méiyǒu, wǒ zài kàn shū — No, I'm reading.

A: *zhè běn shū nǐ kàndǒng le ma* — Do you follow this book?

B: *kàndǒng le* — Yes.

A: 你学会开车了吗

nǐ xuéhuì kāichē le ma — Have you learned to drive?

B: 学会了

xuéhuì le — I have.

Each yes repeats the verb and its result, with 了: 看到了, *kàndǒng le*, 学会了. Each no puts 没 in front: *méi tīngdǒng*.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — five verbs that finish

A verb, then its result; 没 when the result did not come:

- 我看到他了 *wǒ kàndào tā le* — I saw him.
- 我学会开车了 *wǒ xuéhuì kāichē le* — I've learned to drive.
- *wǒ méi tīngdǒng* — I didn't catch it.
- *wǒ zuòwán le* — I've finished.

Listen. *Nǐ kàndào wǒ de shǒujī le ma?*
Speak. Say one thing you have learned how to do, and one thing you have not finished.
Write it: 看到 — 到 ends on the foot of 在, then the right of 前

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你看到他了吗 — *nǐ kàndào tā le ma* — Did you see him?
- *Say it:* 看到了 — *kàndào le* — I did.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我看到他了

Before you move on

Say you saw him. (我看到他了.) Say you didn't catch it. (*wǒ méi tīngdǒng.*) Ask if someone has finished. (*nǐ zuòwán le ma.*)

Chapter 152

Well Said

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how well someone does something.
>
> *Saying how well something is done with a verb,* 得 *and an adjective, fluent, not bad and clear, built on one new written character:* 得.

152.1 得 (de) — how well it is done

A new chapter, and it opens on a small word that says how well.

- *Recall:* say 我看到他了 — *wǒ kàndào tā le* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *zuòwán*, to finish — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *juéde*, to feel; to think — **R2**, a few chapters back
- *Recall:* say 我的书 — *wǒ de shū*, my book — **R4**, recognition at distance

You'll want to know: 得

得 — *de* — the particle between a verb and how well it is done.

> 你说得很好 *nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo* — You speak well.

The next lesson puts the character in your hand. It is the de you already say at the end of *juéde*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

得 (*de*) is written with the character of dé 'to get', inherited from Middle Chinese *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'gain and loss'. Its use as a light particle after a verb is a later development, assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

得 and 的 are two different words, and both are said *de*, with no tone. 的 joins an owner or a description to a noun: 我的书. 得 joins a verb to how well it went: 说得很好.

Your turn

- *Say it: de*, light, with no tone
- *Say it:* 你说得很好 — *nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo* — You speak well.
- *Say it:* 我的书 — *wǒ de shū* — my book: the other de
- *Recall:* say *juéde*, then 说得很好, and hear the same light de

Before you move on

What does 得 join? (**A verb to how well it went**.) And 的? (**An owner or a description to a noun**.)

152.2 得 — the left of 很, then 日, a bar and 寸

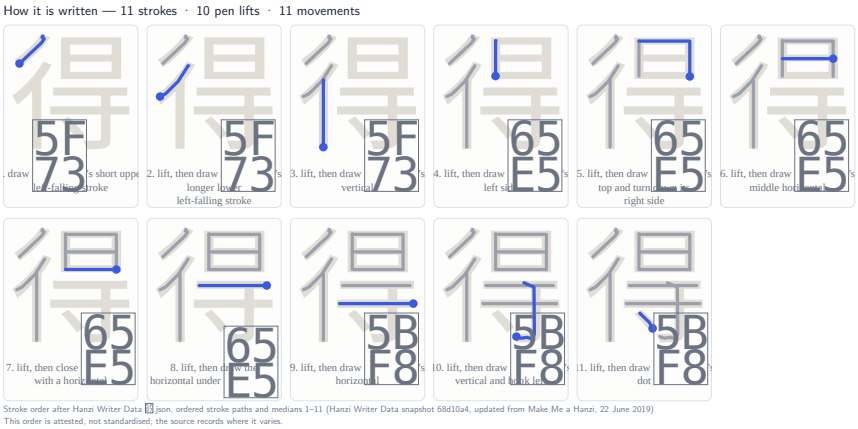
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *de* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  很 时

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hěn*, *shí*

Script — the left of 很, then 日, a bar and 寸



How 得 is written, stroke by stroke

得

Four pieces, and you write every one of them already.

彳**, three strokes**, the left of 很: a short left-falling stroke, a longer one under it, then the vertical down to the foot.

日**, four strokes**, small, at the upper right: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, the bottom bar.

A long bar under 日, across the whole right side.

寸**, three strokes**, under the bar, as on the right of 对 and 时: the bar, the vertical that hooks to the left at its foot, then the dot.

3 + 4 + 1 + 3 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 得, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 得? (**Eleven.**) Which character you write has the same left side? (很.) What sits at the foot on the right? (**寸, as in 对 and 时.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 得, pinned stroke paths and medians.

152.3 你说得很好 — how well, with 得

Three words in a fixed order, and the middle one is the character you have written.

- *Read it:* 说得很好, aloud — *shuō de hěn hǎo*
- *Recall:* say 快 — *kuài*, fast
- *Recall:* say 汉语 — *Hànyǔ*, Chinese

Grammar Lens: the verb, 得, then how well

After a verb, 得 brings in how well or how fast it is done. The adjective after 得 usually takes 很.

你说得很好 *nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo* — You speak well. 他说得很快 *tā shuō de hěn kuài* — He talks fast.

With an object, say the verb twice: once with the object, once with 得:

他说汉语说得很快 *tā shuō Hànyǔ shuō de hěn kuài* — He speaks Chinese fast.

很 here is light, as it is in 你很好: it carries the sentence more than it means *very*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 你说得很好 — *nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo* — You speak well.
- 他说得很快 — *tā shuō de hěn kuài* — He talks fast.
- 他说汉语说得很快 — *tā shuō Hànyǔ shuō de hěn kuài* — He speaks Chinese fast.
- 你做饭做得很好 — *nǐ zuò fàn zuò de hěn hǎo* — You cook well.

Before you move on

What comes after 得? (**How well: an adjective, usually with 很.**) With an object, what do you say twice? (**The verb: 说汉语说得很快.**)

152.4 liúlì — fluent

Before the new one: read the last lesson's sentence, then a word for slow.

- *Read it:* 你说得很好, aloud — *nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo*
- *Recall:* say *màn*, slow — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: liúlì

liúlì — "fluent".

tā Hànyǔ shuō de hěn liúlì — He speaks Chinese fluently.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúlì is built from liú 'to flow' and lì. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *lijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun explains *ljuw*, after an older dictionary, as water moving, and glosses *lijH* 'favourable' and, after the same dictionary, 'sharp'. 'Fluent' is the pair's own sense.

What you've built

liúlì sits after 得 with 很, as the other adjectives do: *shuō de hěn liúlì*. Here the topic, Hànyǔ, goes first, so the verb is said only once.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúlì*
- *Say it: liúlì*, once more
- *Say it: tā Hànyǔ shuō de hěn liúlì* — He speaks Chinese fluently.

- *Recall:* say *màn*, then *liúlì*: slow, then smooth

Before you move on

What does *liúlì* mean? ("Fluent".) Where does it go? (**After 得, with 很.**)

152.5 búcuò — not bad; pretty good

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the word this one says no to.

- *Recall:* say *liúlì*, fluent — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *cuò*, wrong — **R2**, a few chapters back
- *Recall:* say *róngyì*, easy — **R2**

You'll want to know: búcuò

búcuò — "not bad; pretty good".

nǐ zuò de búcuò — You did pretty well.

不 rises before the fall of cuò: *búcuò*, as in *bú qù*.
Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

búcuò is built from 不 'not' and *cuò* 'wrong', the word you know: not wrong, so pretty good. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *tshak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun glosses *tshak* 'mixed' and 'crossing slantwise', and how it came to mean wrong is not settled.

What you've built

búcuò is praise that sounds modest. After 得 it needs no 很: *zuò de búcuò*.
On its own it answers how something was: *hěn búcuò*, really quite good.

Your turn

- *Say it: búcuò*
- *Say it: búcuò*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuò de búcuò* — You did pretty well.
- *Recall:* say *cuò*, then *búcuò*

Before you move on

What does *búcuò* mean? ("Not bad; pretty good".) What does 不 do before cuò? (**It rises: *bú***.)

152.6 qīngchu — clear; clearly

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words for how a thing is.

- *Recall:* say *búcuò*, pretty good — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 重要 — *zhòngyào*, important — **R2**, a few chapters back
- *Recall:* say *jiǎndān*, simple — **R2**

You'll want to know: qīngchu

qīngchu — "clear; clearly".

tā shuō de hěn qīngchu — He speaks clearly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīngchu is built from qīng 'clear' and chu. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjeng* and *tsrhjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the first is glossed 'clear, far from mud'. The Guangyun gives *tsrhjoX* as a plant and a place name, so how it came into 'clear' is not settled.

What you've built

qīngchu answers how well something came across: *shuō de hěn qīngchu*, said clearly.
It is light at the end, *chu* with no tone.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīngchu*
- *Say it: qīngchu*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō de hěn qīngchu* — He speaks clearly.
- *Recall:* say *jiǎndān*, then *qīngchu*

Before you move on

What does *qīngchu* mean? ("Clear; clearly".) Say he speaks clearly. (*tā shuō de hěn qīngchu.*)

152.7 他说汉语说得很快

The chapter closes here, with two people trading compliments.

- *Recall:* say *qīngchu*, clear — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *búcuò*, pretty good — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *liúlì*, fluent — **R2**

The exchange

A: 他说汉语说得很快

tā shuō Hànyǔ shuō de hěn kuài — He speaks Chinese fast.

B: 对 他说得很好

duì, tā shuō de hěn hǎo — Yes, and he speaks well.

A: *tā Hànyǔ shuō de hěn liúlì* — His Chinese is fluent.

B: 你呢

nǐ ne — And you?

A: *wǒ shuō de hěn màn* — I speak slowly.

B: *nǐ shuō de hěn qīngchu* — You speak clearly.

A: 你做饭做得很好

nǐ zuò fàn zuò de hěn hǎo — You cook well.

B: *búcuò, wǒ juéde hěn jiǎndān* — Not bad. I find it simple.

Every compliment has the same order: the verb, 得, then how well. When the object comes along, the verb is said twice; when the language goes first as the topic, once.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — how well

The verb, 得, then how well; say the verb twice when it has an object:

- 你说得很好 *nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo* — you speak well.
- 他说汉语说得很快 *tā shuō Hànyǔ shuō de hěn kuài* — he speaks Chinese fast.
- *tā shuō de hěn qīngchu* — he speaks clearly.
- *nǐ zuò de búcuò* — you did pretty well.

Listen. *Tā Hànyǔ shuō de zěnmeyàng?*
Speak. Say how well somebody you know cooks, then how fast you speak.
Write it: 得 — the left of 很, then 日, a long bar, and the right of 对

Your turn

- *Say it:* 他说汉语说得很快 — *tā shuō Hànyǔ shuō de hěn kuài* — He speaks Chinese fast.

- *Say it: nǐ shuō de hěn qīngchu* — You speak clearly.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 你说得很好

Before you move on

Say he speaks Chinese fast. (他说汉语说得很快.) Say someone speaks fluently. (*tā shuō de hěn liúlì*.) Say not bad. (*búcuò*.)

Chapter 153

Older Than Me

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can compare two people or things.
>
> *Comparing two people or things with* 比*, saying by how much, even more, the same as, and not as much as, built on one new written character:* 比.

153.1 比 (bǐ) — than; compared with

A new chapter, and it opens on the word that sets two things side by side.

- *Recall:* say 他说汉语说得很快 — *tā shuō Hànyǔ shuō de hěn kuài* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *qīngchu*, clear — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *yíyàng*, the same — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *bǐ*, a pen — **R2**, a few chapters back

You'll want to know: 比

比 — *bǐ* — "than; compared with".

> 我比他大 *wǒ bǐ tā dà* — I'm older than him.

The next lesson puts the character in your hand. It sounds like *bǐ*, a pen, and it is a different word.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

比 (*bǐ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to compare; side by side'. It is the bǐ of *bǐsài*, a match. The *bǐ* of *qiānbǐ*, a pencil, is another word with the same sound.

What you've built

比 sits between the two things compared, and the adjective comes last: 我, 比, 他, 大.
大 for people is old: 我比他大 is I'm older than him. 比 itself is the bǐ of *bǐsài*, a match: two sides set against each other.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǐ*
- *Say it: bǐ*, once more
- *Say it:* 我比他大 — *wǒ bǐ tā dà* — I'm older than him.
- *Say it:* 他比我大 — *tā bǐ wǒ dà* — He's older than me.
- *Recall:* say *bǐ*, a pen, then 比, than: one sound, two words

Before you move on

What does 比 mean? ("Than; compared with".) Where does the adjective go? (**Last:** 我比他大.)

153.2 比 — two halves side by side, the left one first

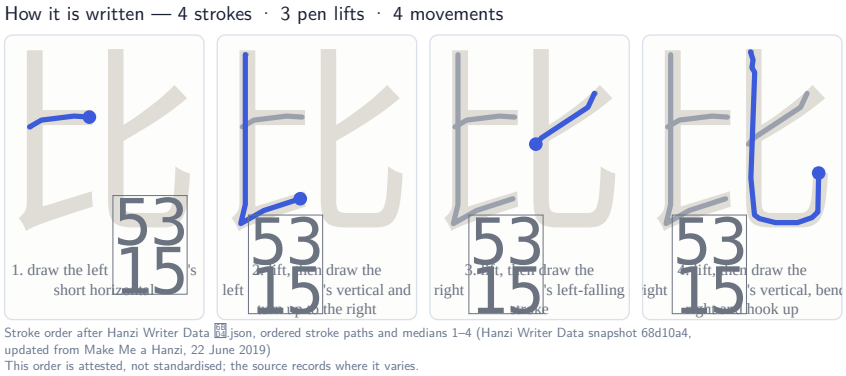
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  能 七

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *néng*, *qī*

Script — two halves side by side, the left one first



How 比 *is written, stroke by stroke*

比

Two halves, side by side, the left one first. The right half you write already, twice over, on the right of 能.

The left half, two strokes: a short bar, then a vertical that runs down and turns up to the right at its foot.

The right half, two strokes, as on the right of 能: a short left-falling stroke, then a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up, the same movement that ends 七.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 比, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 比? (**Four**.) Which half comes first? (**The left**.) Where have you written the right half? (**On the right of** 能.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 比, pinned stroke paths and medians.

153.3 他比我大两岁 — comparing with 比

Two people, one comparison, and then by how much.

- *Read it:* 我比他大, aloud — *wǒ bǐ tā dà*
- *Recall:* say 二十岁 — *èrshí suì*, twenty years old
- *Recall:* say *zuì*, most

Grammar Lens: 比, then the adjective, then by how much

A, 比, B, then the adjective: A is more so than B. How much more goes after the adjective, at the very end.

我比他大 *wǒ bǐ tā dà* — I'm older than him. 他比我大两岁 *tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì* — He's two years older than me. 这个比那个大一点儿 *zhège bǐ nàge dà yìdiǎnr* — This one is a bit bigger than that one.

There is no 很 in these. 很 describes one thing on its own; a comparison sets two against each other. 他很大 describes him; 他比我大 measures him against me.
The other way round, not as much as, comes with 没有:

我没有他那么大 *wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme dà* — I'm not as old as he is.

And *zuì*, most, needs no second thing at all: *tā zuì dà*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 他比我大两岁 — *tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì* — He's two years older than me.
- 这个比那个大一点儿 — *zhège bǐ nàge dà yìdiǎnr* — This one is a bit bigger than that one.
- 我没有他那么大 — *wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme dà* — I'm not as old as he is.
- *jīntiān bǐ míngtiān rè* — Today is hotter than tomorrow.

Before you move on

Where does 比 go? (**Between the two things.**) Where does by how much go? (**At the very end:** 大两岁.) Does 很 go in? (**No.**)

153.4 gèng — even more

Before the new one: read the last lesson's sentence, then a word for tall.

- *Read it:* 他比我大两岁, aloud — *tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì*
- *Recall:* say *gāo*, tall — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: gèng

gèng — "even more; still more".

tā gèng gāo — He's even taller.

tā bǐ wǒ gèng gāo — He's even taller than me.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gèng is inherited from Middle Chinese *kaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to change; to alter'. 'Even more' is a later sense, assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

gèng goes straight before the adjective: *tā gèng gāo*.
With 比 it sharpens the comparison: both are tall, and he is taller still.

Your turn

- *Say it: gèng*
- *Say it: gèng*, once more
- *Say it: tā gèng gāo* — He's even taller.

- *Say it: tā bǐ wǒ gèng gāo* — He's even taller than me.
- *Recall:* say *gāo*, then *gèng gāo*

Before you move on

What does *gèng* mean? ("Even more".) Where does it go? (**Straight before the adjective**.)

153.5 gēn — with; the same as

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the word for the same.

- *Recall:* say *gèng*, even more — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *yíyàng*, the same — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: gēn

gēn — "with; and"; with *yíyàng* after it, "the same as".

wǒ gēn tā yíyàng gāo — I'm as tall as he is.

wǒ gēn māma qù — I'm going with Mum.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēn is inherited from Middle Chinese *kon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the heel'. How the heel became 'with', following at someone's heels, is a guess the gloss does not make, so the history is not settled.

What you've built

gēn … yíyàng, then an adjective, says two things are the same: *wǒ gēn tā yíyàng gāo*.
比 says one is more; *gēn … yíyàng* says neither is.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēn*
- *Say it: gēn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēn tā yíyàng gāo* — I'm as tall as he is.
- *Say it: wǒ gēn māma qù* — I'm going with Mum.
- *Recall:* say *yíyàng*, then *gēn tā yíyàng*

Before you move on

What does *gēn* mean? ("With; and".) And *gēn … yíyàng*? (**The same as**.)

153.6 那么 (nàme) — so; that much

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the two words this one is made of.

- *Recall:* say *gēn*, with — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 那 — *nà*, that — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say 什么 — *shénme*, what — **R4**

You'll want to know: 那么

那么 — *nàme* — "so; that (much)".

我没有他那么大 *wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme dà* — I'm not as old as he is.

那么大 *nàme dà* — that big

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

那么 (*nàme*) is built from 那 'that' and 么, the 么 of 什么. The Guangyun records 那 as *na* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'how; what'; how it came to mean 'that', and where the ending 么 comes from, are not settled.

What you've built

没有 … 那么, with an adjective after it, says not as much as: 我没有他那么大.
It is the other side of 比: 他比我大, so 我没有他那么大.

Your turn

- *Say it: nàme*
- *Say it: nàme*, once more
- *Say it:* 我没有他那么大 — *wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme dà* — I'm not as old as he is.
- *Say it:* 他比我大 — *tā bǐ wǒ dà* — He's older than me.
- *Recall:* say 那 and 什么, then 那么

Before you move on

What does 那么 mean? ("So; that much".) Say you are not as old as him. (我没有他那么大.)

153.7 我比他大 — 我没有他那么大

The chapter closes here, with two people comparing a family.

- *Recall:* say 那么 — *nàme*, so — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *gēn … yíyàng*, the same as — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *gèng*, even more — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你多大

nǐ duō dà — How old are you?

B: 我二十岁

wǒ èrshí suì — I'm twenty.

A: 他呢

tā ne — And him?

B: 他比我大两岁

tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì — He's two years older than me.

A: *nǐ bǐ tā gāo ma* — Are you taller than him?

B: *wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme gāo* — I'm not as tall as he is.

A: 你妈妈呢

nǐ māma ne — And your mum?

B: *tā gēn wǒ yíyàng gāo* — She's as tall as me.

A: *wǒ bǐ tā dà, tā gèng gāo* — I'm older than him, and he's taller still.

比 puts the difference last: 大两岁. 没有 … 那么 turns it round. *gēn* … *yíyàng* says neither is more.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — more, less and the same

Three ways to set two things side by side:

- 他比我大两岁 *tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì* — he's two years older than me.
- 我没有他那么大 *wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme dà* — I'm not as old as he is.
- *wǒ gēn tā yíyàng gāo* — I'm as tall as he is.

Listen. *Nǐ bǐ nǐ māma gāo ma?*
Speak. Compare yourself with somebody you know: older or younger, taller or not as tall.
Write it: 比 — the left half first, then the right half of 能

Your turn

- *Say it:* 他比我大两岁 — *tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì* — He's two years older than me.
- *Say it:* 我没有他那么大 — *wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme dà* — I'm not as old as he is.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我比他大

Before you move on

Say you are older than him. (我比他大.) Say you are not as old as him. (我没有他那么大.) Say you are as tall as he is. (*wǒ gēn tā yíyàng gāo.*)

Chapter 154

This One or That One

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask 'this or that?', say 'not yet' and 'don't'.
>
> *Still and not yet with* 还*, asking which of two with* 还是*, offering either with huòzhě, and don't with bié, built on one new written character:* 还.

154.1 还 (hái) — still; yet

A new chapter, and it opens on a word for what has not changed yet.

- *Recall:* say 我比他大 — *wǒ bǐ tā dà* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 那么 — *nàme* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *hái xíng*, not bad — **R4**, recognition at distance
- *Recall:* say *yǐjīng*, already — **R2**, a few chapters back

You'll want to know: 还

还 — *hái* — "still; yet".

他还在家 *tā hái zài jiā* — He's still at home.

我还没吃饭 *wǒ hái méi chī fàn* — I haven't eaten yet.

The next lesson puts the character in your hand. It is the hái of *hái xíng*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

还 (*hái*) is the hái of *hái xíng*, inherited from Middle Chinese *hwaen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to return'. The regular sound change gives huán, the *huán* 'to give back' you know, not hái; how hái split off from it, and how it came to mean 'still', are not settled.

What you've built

还 goes before the verb: still. 还没 before a verb is not yet: 我还没吃饭.
Set it against *yǐjīng*, already: *wǒ yǐjīng chī le*, I've eaten already; 我还没吃饭, not yet.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *hái*
- *Say it:* *hái*, once more
- *Say it:* 他还在家 — *tā hái zài jiā* — He's still at home.
- *Say it:* 我还没吃饭 — *wǒ hái méi chī fàn* — I haven't eaten yet.
- *Recall:* say *yǐjīng*, then 还没

Before you move on

What does 还 mean? ("Still; yet".) How do you say not yet? (**还没, before the verb.**)

154.2 还 — 不, then the walking piece last

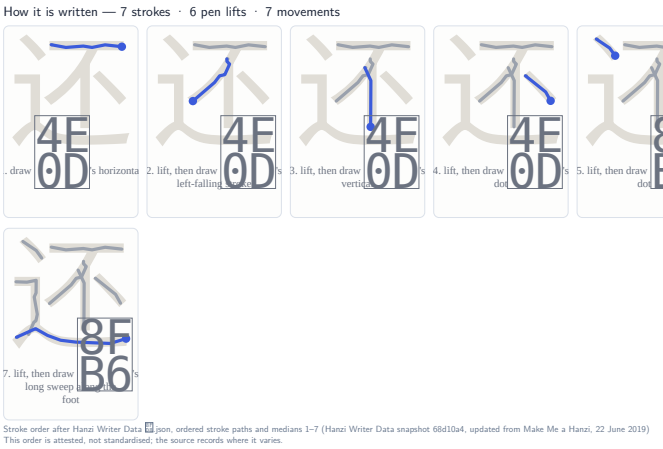
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *hái* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  不 这 过

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bù*, *zhè*, *guò*

Script — 不, then the walking piece last



How 还 *is written, stroke by stroke*

还

Two pieces you own, in the order of 这 and 过.

不**, four strokes**, on the upper right: the bar, the left-falling stroke, the vertical, the dot.

辶**, three strokes**, last: the dot, the stroke that turns down, turns again and falls to the left, then the long base under 不.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 还, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 还? (**Seven.**) Which piece goes in first? (不.) Which other characters put the walking piece last? (**这, 进 and** 过.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 还, pinned stroke paths and medians.

154.3 还是 (háishi) — or, in a question

Before the new one: read the character you have written, then a sentence with 要.

- *Read it:* 还没, aloud — *hái méi*, not yet
- *Recall:* say 我要水 — *wǒ yào shuǐ*, I want some water — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 还是

还是 — *háishi* — "or", in a question.

你要水还是要饭 *nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn* — Do you want water or food?

你去还是他去 *nǐ qù háishi tā qù* — Are you going, or is he?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

还是 (*háishi*) is built from 还 'still', the character you have written, and 是 'to be'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwaen* and *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); 'or' is the pair's own sense, which neither gloss gives.

What you've built

还是 goes between the two choices, and the answer picks one: 我要水. Each choice can keep its own verb: 要水还是要饭. The question needs no 吗: 还是 already makes it one.

Your turn

- *Say it: háishi*
- *Say it: háishi*, once more
- *Say it:* 你要水还是要饭 — *nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn* — Do you want water or food?
- *Say it:* 我要水 — *wǒ yào shuǐ* — Water, please.
- *Recall:* say 还没, then 还是, and hear the same hái

Before you move on

What does 还是 do? (**Asks which of two.**) Does the question need 吗? (**No.**)

154.4 huòzhě — or, in a statement

Before the new one: last lesson's sentence, then the or that asks.

- *Recall:* say 你要水还是要饭 — *nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 我还没吃饭 — *wǒ hái méi chī fàn* — **R1**, this chapter

You'll want to know: huòzhě

huòzhě — "or", in a statement.

míngtiān huòzhě hòutiān dōu kěyǐ — Tomorrow or the day after: either is fine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huòzhě is built from huò and zhě. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwok* and *tsyaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'not fixed; in doubt' and 'a particle'. 'Or' for the pair is assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

还是 asks; *huòzhě* states. 你去还是他去 *nǐ qù háishi tā qù* wants an answer; *nǐ qù huòzhě tā qù dōu kěyǐ* says either will do.
都 after the two choices says both are fine.

Your turn

- *Say it: huòzhě*
- *Say it: huòzhě*, once more

- *Say it: míngtiān huòzhě hòutiān dōu kěyǐ* — Tomorrow or the day after: either is fine.
- *Say it:* 你去还是他去 — *nǐ qù háishi tā qù* — Are you going, or is he?
- *Recall:* say 还是, then *huòzhě*: one asks, one states

Before you move on

Which or asks, 还是 or *huòzhě*? (还是.) Which one states? (***huòzhě***.)

154.5 bié — don't

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the don't you already know.

- *Recall:* say *huòzhě*, or — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 不要说 — *bú yào shuō*, don't say it — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *biérén*, other people — **R2**

You'll want to know: bié

bié — "don't".

bié qù — Don't go.

bié shuō le — Don't say any more.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bié is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'different; to part'. It is the bié of *biérén* and *biéde*. How it came to mean 'don't' is not settled.

What you've built

bié and 不要 both stop someone: *bié qù* and 不要去 say the same thing, and *bié* is shorter.
With 了 at the end it means stop now, enough: *bié shuō le*.

Your turn

- *Say it: bié*
- *Say it: bié*, once more
- *Say it: bié qù* — Don't go.
- *Say it:* 不要去 — *bú yào qù* — Don't go.
- *Say it: bié shuō le* — Don't say any more.
- *Recall:* say 不要说, then *bié shuō*

Before you move on

What does *bié* mean? ("Don't".) Which longer words say the same? (不要.)

154.6 你要水还是要饭

The chapter closes here, with two people choosing between things.

- *Recall:* say *bié*, don't — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *huòzhě*, or — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 还没 — *hái méi*, not yet — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你要水还是要饭

nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn — Do you want water or food?

B: 我要水

wǒ yào shuǐ — Water, please.

A: 你吃饭了吗

nǐ chī fàn le ma — Have you eaten?

B: 还没

hái méi — Not yet.

A: 我们去吃饭还是在家吃

wǒmen qù chī fàn háishi zài jiā chī — Shall we go out to eat, or eat at home?

B: 在家吃 妈妈还在做饭

zài jiā chī, māma hái zài zuò fàn — At home. Mum's still cooking.

A: 我们明天去还是后天去

wǒmen míngtiān qù háishi hòutiān qù — Are we going tomorrow or the day after?

B: *míngtiān huòzhě hòutiān dōu kěyǐ* — Tomorrow or the day after: either is fine.

A: *hǎo, bié wàng le* — Fine. Don't forget.

还是 asks, and the answer picks one; *huòzhě* refuses to pick. 还没 is a whole answer: not yet. *bié wàng le*: don't forget.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — or, still, not yet, don't

Four small words that steer a conversation:

- 你要水还是要饭 *nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn* — water or food?

- *míngtiān huòzhě hòutiān dōu kěyǐ* — tomorrow or the day after, either is fine.
- 我还没吃饭 *wǒ hái méi chī fàn* — I haven't eaten yet.
- *bié qù* — don't go.

Listen. *Nǐ hē chá háishi hē shuǐ?*
Speak. Offer a friend two choices, then tell them not to forget.
Write it: 还 — 不 first, the walking piece last

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你要水还是要饭 — *nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn* — Do you want water or food?
- *Say it:* 还没 — *hái méi* — Not yet.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 你要水还是要饭

Before you move on

Ask water or food. (你要水还是要饭.) Say not yet. (还没.) Say either is fine. (*míngtiān huòzhě hòutiān dōu kěyǐ*.) Say don't go. (*bié qù*.)

Chapter 155

Trains and Opening Hours

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find times in a timetable and opening hours.
>
> *Reading a station timetable and a bookshop's opening hours, with* 从 *…* 到 *…, setting off, opening and closing, built on one new written character:* 从.

155.1 从 (cóng) — from

A new chapter, and it opens on the word for where things start.

- *Recall:* say 你要水还是要饭 — *nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *bié*, don't — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *cónglái*, ever — **R2**, a few chapters back

You'll want to know: 从

从 — *cóng* — "from".

从这儿到大学 *cóng zhèr dào dàxué* — from here to the university

我从中国来 *wǒ cóng Zhōngguó lái* — I come from China.

The next lesson puts the character in your hand. It is the cóng of *cónglái*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

从 (*cóng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to go to; to follow'. 'From' is a later sense, assumed here, not quoted. It is the cóng of *cónglái*.

What you've built

从 comes before the starting point, and the whole phrase goes before the verb: 我, 从中国, 来.
到 after it marks where things end: 从这儿到大学.

Your turn

- *Say it: cóng*
- *Say it: cóng*, once more
- *Say it:* 从这儿到大学 — *cóng zhèr dào dàxué* — from here to the university
- *Say it:* 我从中国来 — *wǒ cóng Zhōngguó lái* — I come from China.
- *Recall:* say *cónglái*, then 从, and hear the same cóng

Before you move on

What does 从 mean? ("From".) Where does 从 and its place go? (**Before the verb:** 我从中国来.)

155.2 从 — 人 twice, the left one narrower

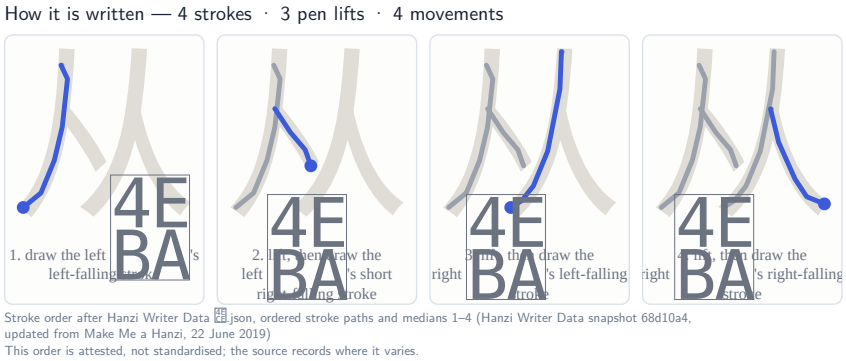
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *cóng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

人 个

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *gè*

Script — 人 twice, the left one narrower



How 从 is written, stroke by stroke

从

One piece you own, written twice.

The left 人, two strokes, narrow: the left-falling stroke, then a short stroke falling to the right that stops early, almost a dot, so the second 人 has room.

The right 人, two strokes, full size: the left-falling stroke, then the long stroke falling to the right.

2 + 2 = four. One person following another.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 从, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 从? (**Four**.) Which 人 is narrower? (**The left**.) What happens to its second stroke? (**It stops early, almost a dot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 从, pinned stroke paths and medians.

155.3 从八点到十点 — from and to

Two characters you write, a start and an end.

- *Read it:* 从这儿, aloud — *cóng zhèr*
- *Recall:* say *jǐ diǎn*, what time
- *Recall:* say *zhǔnshí*, on time

Grammar Lens: 从 ... 到 ..., a start and an end

从 marks where something starts, 到 where it ends. A time or a place goes after each.

从八点到十点 *cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn* — from eight to ten o'clock 从这儿到大学 *cóng zhèr dào dàxué* — from here to the university

On a sign, 到 often stands alone between two days or two times, with 从 left out:

星期一到星期五 *xīngqīyī dào xīngqīwǔ* — Monday to Friday

In a sentence the whole phrase goes before the verb:

我从八点到十点上课 *wǒ cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn shàngkè* — I have class from eight to ten.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 从八点到十点 — *cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn* — from eight to ten o'clock
- 从这儿到大学 — *cóng zhèr dào dàxué* — from here to the university
- 星期一到星期五 — *xīngqīyī dào xīngqīwǔ* — Monday to Friday
- 我从八点到十点上课 — *wǒ cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn shàngkè* — I have class from eight to ten.

Before you move on

What does 从 mark? (**Where it starts.**) And 到? (**Where it ends.**) What can a sign leave out? (从: 星期一到星期五.)

155.4 chūfā — to set off; to depart

Before the new one: read the last lesson's phrase, then going out of the door.

- *Read it:* 从八点到十点, aloud — *cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn*
- *Recall:* say *chūmén*, to go out — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: chūfā

chūfā — "to set off; to depart".

huǒchē bā diǎn chūfā — The train leaves at eight.

wǒmen jǐ diǎn chūfā — What time do we set off?

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūfā is built from 出 'to go out', the 出 you write, and fā 'to send off; to start', the fā of *fāshāo*. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to go forward; to appear' and 'to start up'.

What you've built

chūfā says when a journey starts; 到 says when it arrives: *bā diǎn chūfā, shí diǎn dào.*
On a timetable the start is often written 开, as a train or a bus 开 when it leaves.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūfā*

- *Say it: chūfā*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē bā diǎn chūfā* — The train leaves at eight.
- *Say it: wǒmen jǐ diǎn chūfā* — What time do we set off?
- *Recall:* say *chūmén*, then *chūfā*

Before you move on

What does *chūfā* mean? ("To set off".) And to arrive? (到.)

155.5 开门 (kāimén) — to open; to be open

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the two words this one is made of.

- *Recall:* say *chūfā*, to set off — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *kāi*, to open — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 门 — *mén*, a door — **R3**

You'll want to know: 开门

开门 — *kāimén* — "to open (for business); to open the door".

星期天不开门 *xīngqītiān bù kāimén* — It's closed on Sundays.

早上九点开门 *zǎoshang jiǔ diǎn kāimén* — It opens at nine in the morning.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开门 (*kāimén*) is built from 开 'to open' and 门 'a door'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), *khoj* glossed 'to open; to undo'.

What you've built

A shop that 开门 is open for business, not only its door. On a sign the hours come first: 早上九点到晚上八点开门.
不 stays *bù* before the level tone of kāi: 不开门.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāimén*
- *Say it: kāimén*, once more
- *Say it:* 星期天不开门 — *xīngqītiān bù kāimén* — It's closed on Sundays.
- *Say it:* 早上九点开门 — *zǎoshang jiǔ diǎn kāimén* — It opens at nine in the morning.
- *Recall:* say *kāi* and 门, then 开门

Before you move on

What does 开门 mean on a shop? (**It is open for business**.) Say it is closed on Sundays. (星期天不开门.)

155.6 guānmén — to close; to shut the door

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the verb for shutting.

- *Recall:* say 开门 — *kāimén* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *guān*, to close — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: guānmén

guānmén — "to close (for the day); to shut the door".

wǎnshang bā diǎn guānmén — It closes at eight in the evening.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guānmén is built from *guān* 'to close', the word you know, and 门 'a door'. *guān* is inherited from Middle Chinese *kwaen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary explains, through an older book, as a wooden bar held across a door.

What you've built

开门 and *guānmén* bracket a shop's day: *zǎoshang jiǔ diǎn kāimén, wǎnshang bā diǎn guānmén.*
A sign often gives only the span, with 到 between: 九点到八点.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānmén*
- *Say it: guānmén*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang bā diǎn guānmén* — It closes at eight in the evening.
- *Recall:* say 开门, then *guānmén*

Before you move on

What does *guānmén* mean? ("To close for the day".) And to open? (开门.)

155.7 (reading) — a timetable and opening hours

Two notices, the kind you read standing up: a station timetable, then a bookshop's door.

- *Recall:* say *guānmén*, to close — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *fēnzhōng*, a minute — **R2**, the chapter on the clock

十点半

Read it: it aloud, with nothing said first — *shí diǎn bàn*

Read this

从这儿到大学的火车 早上八点开 十点半到 下午两点开 四点半到 晚上七点开 九点到

书 星期一到星期五 早上九点到晚上八点开门 星期六 上午十点到下午五点开门 星期天不开门

Read it: both notices through once without stopping; do not translate as you go
Read it: the timetable again, and find the train that arrives before eleven

Read this

cóng zhèr dào dàxué de huǒchē zǎoshang bā diǎn kāi, shí diǎn bàn dào xiàwǔ liǎng diǎn kāi, sì diǎn bàn dào wǎnshang qī diǎn kāi, jiǔ diǎn dào

shū xīngqīyī dào xīngqīwǔ zǎoshang jiǔ diǎn dào wǎnshang bā diǎn kāimén xīngqīliù shàngwǔ shí diǎn dào xiàwǔ wǔ diǎn kāimén xīngqītiān bù kāimén

A timetable leaves out every word it can. 开 is the train leaving and 到 is it arriving; the shop's name is one character, 书, and its hours are two times with 到 between them and 开门 after.

Your turn

- You must be at the university by eleven: which train? (**The eight o'clock:** 早上八点开 十点半到.)
- Can you buy a book on Sunday? (**No:** 星期天不开门.)
- What time does the bookshop open on Saturday? (**Ten in the morning:** 上午十点.)
- *Say it:* the timetable aloud, once, without stopping

Before you move on

When does the last train arrive? (九点, nine in the evening.) Which day is the shop shut? (星期天.) How late is it open on a weekday? (晚上八点.)

155.8 火车十点半到

The chapter closes here: the same timetable and the same door, asked about aloud.

- *Recall:* say 星期天不开门 — *xīngqītiān bù kāimén* — **R1**, the reading
- *Recall:* say *chūfā*, to set off — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *guānmén*, to close — **R2**

The exchange

A: *qǐngwèn, huǒchē jǐ diǎn chūfā* — Excuse me, what time does the train leave?

B: 早上八点开

zǎoshang bā diǎn kāi — At eight in the morning.

A: *jǐ diǎn dào dàxué* — What time does it get to the university?

B: 十点半到

shí diǎn bàn dào — At half past ten.

A: 书 星期天开门吗

shū, xīngqītiān kāimén ma — The bookshop: is it open on Sunday?

B: 星期天不开门

xīngqītiān bù kāimén — It's closed on Sundays.

A: 星期六呢

xīngqīliù ne — And Saturday?

B: 上午十点到下午五点开门

shàngwǔ shí diǎn dào xiàwǔ wǔ diǎn kāimén — Open from ten to five.

A: *xiàwǔ wǔ diǎn guānmén* — So it closes at five.

The questions come in pinyin, because *jǐ* is not a character you write yet; the answers come off the notices, in characters.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — reading the times off a notice

A start, an end, and a verb for what happens:

- 早上八点开 十点半到 *zǎoshang bā diǎn kāi, shí diǎn bàn dào* — leaves at eight, arrives at half past ten.
- 从八点到十点 *cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn* — from eight to ten.
- 星期一到星期五 *xīngqīyī dào xīngqīwǔ* — Monday to Friday.
- *wǎnshang bā diǎn guānmén* — closes at eight in the evening.

Listen. *Huǒchē jǐ diǎn dào?*
Speak. Give the hours of a shop you know, from opening to closing.
Write it: 十点半到 — then 从, one 人 following another

Your turn

- *Say it: huǒchē jǐ diǎn dào* — What time does the train arrive?
- *Say it:* 十点半到 — *shí diǎn bàn dào* — At half past ten.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 从八点到十点

Before you move on

Say the train arrives at half past ten. (十点半到.) Say it's closed on Sundays. (星期天不开门.) Say from eight to ten. (从八点到十点.)

Chapter 156

Price List

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (2) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find prices in a price list and an advert.
>
> *Reading a shop's price list and an advert, prices written in* 元 *and said in kuài, the price, free of charge and an advert, built on one new written character:* 元.

156.1 元 (yuán) — yuan, as written

A new chapter, and it opens on how much things cost.

- *Recall:* say 火车十点半到 — *huǒchē shí diǎn bàn dào* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *guānmén*, to close — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *kuài*, yuan, as said — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 多少 — *duōshao*, how much — **R3**

You'll want to know: 元

元 — *yuán* — "yuan", the unit of money, as it is written.

一本书十元 *yì běn shū shí yuán* — A book costs ten yuan.

On a price list it is written 元; aloud, most people say *kuài*: *shí kuài*. The next lesson puts the character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

元 (*yuán*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'great; the beginning; the head'. The unit of money is a modern sense, assumed here, not quoted.

What you've built

The number, then 元: 十元. A thing's price follows the thing: 一本书, 十元.
When you say it, swap in *kuài*: *yì běn shū shí kuài*. 一 falls before the dip of běn: *yì běn*.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuán*
- *Say it: yuán*, once more
- *Say it:* 一本书十元 — *yì běn shū shí yuán* — A book costs ten yuan.
- *Say it: yì běn shū shí kuài* — the same price, as people say it
- *Recall:* say *kuài*, then 元

Before you move on

What does 元 mean? (**Yuan, as written**.) How do people say it aloud? (***kuài***.)

156.2 元 — 二, then 儿 under it

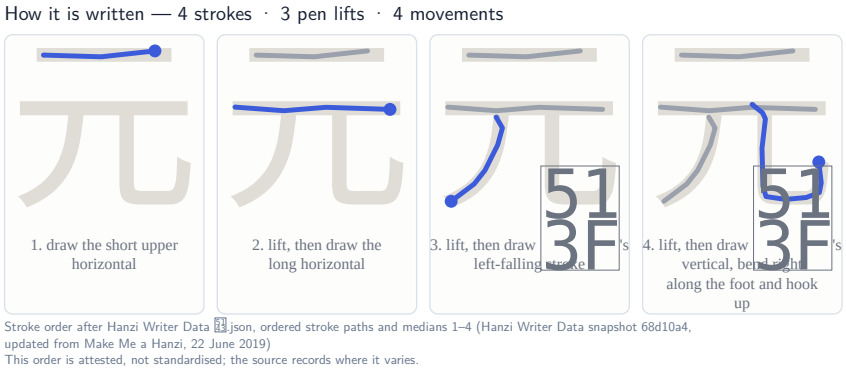
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yuán* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  二 儿

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *èr*, *ér*

Script — 二, then 儿 under it



How 元 is written, stroke by stroke

元

Two characters you own, one above the other.
二, two strokes: the short upper bar, then the longer lower bar.
儿, two strokes, under them: the left-falling stroke, then the vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up.
2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 元, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 元? (**Four**.) Which character is on top? (二.) And under it? (儿.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 元, pinned stroke paths and medians.

156.3 jiàqián — price

Before the new one: read the last lesson's character in a price, then two words for money.

- *Read it:* 十元, aloud — *shí yuán*
- *Recall:* say *qián*, money — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *guì*, expensive — **R3**

You'll want to know: jiàqián

jiàqián — "price".

jiàqián tài guì le — The price is too high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàqián is built from jià 'price' and *qián* 'money', the word you know. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaeH* and *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'price; value' and 'coin'. The jià of *fàngjià*, a holiday, sounds the same and is a different word.

What you've built

jiàqián names the price as a fact, the figure on the list; *duōshao qián* asks it aloud.
太 … 了 is still the complaint: *jiàqián tài guì le*.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàqián*
- *Say it: jiàqián*, once more
- *Say it: jiàqián tài guì le* — The price is too high.
- *Recall:* say *qián*, then *jiàqián*

Before you move on

What does *jiàqián* mean? ("Price".) How do you ask a price aloud? (*duōshao qián*.)

156.4 miǎnfèi — free of charge

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then the word for buying.

- *Recall:* say *jiàqián*, price — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 买 — *mǎi*, to buy — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: miǎnfèi

miǎnfèi — "free (of charge)".

shuǐ miǎnfèi — The water's free.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

miǎnfèi is built from miǎn 'to be spared' and fèi 'cost'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjenX* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to escape; to remove' and 'to use up; to spend'. Spared the spending: free.

What you've built

miǎnfèi follows the thing, as a price does: *shuǐ miǎnfèi*, where a price list would say 水 一元.
Its first syllable dips: *miǎn*.

Your turn

- *Say it: miǎnfèi*
- *Say it: miǎnfèi*, once more
- *Say it: shuǐ miǎnfèi* — The water's free.
- *Recall:* say 买, then *miǎnfèi*

Before you move on

What does *miǎnfèi* mean? ("Free of charge".) Where does it go? (**After the thing, as a price does**.)

156.5 guǎnggào — advert

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a thing worth advertising.

- *Recall:* say *miǎnfèi*, free — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 手机 — *shǒujī*, a phone — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: guǎnggào

guǎnggào — "advert; advertisement".

zhè shì shǒujī de guǎnggào — This is an advert for a phone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǎnggào is built from guǎng 'wide' and gào 'to tell'. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwangX* and *kawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'broad' and 'to report': telling widely. 'An advert' is the pair's modern sense.

What you've built

的 joins the thing to the advert: *shǒujī de guǎnggào*, an advert for a phone.
An advert often has a price and a day on it, and little else.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǎnggào*
- *Say it: guǎnggào*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì shǒujī de guǎnggào* — This is an advert for a phone.
- *Recall:* say *miǎnfèi*, then *guǎnggào*

Before you move on

What does *guǎnggào* mean? ("An advert".) How do you say an advert for a phone? (*shǒujī de guǎnggào*.)

156.6 (reading) — a price list and an advert

A shop's price list, then an advert under it.

- *Recall:* say *guǎnggào*, an advert — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 白菜 — *báicài*, cabbage — **R3**, durable

本子

Read it: it aloud, with nothing said first — *běnzi*

Read this

书 十元一本 本子 两元一本 大白菜 三元 水 一元 手机 九百九十九元

星期六和星期天 两本书十五元

Read it: the list through once without stopping; do not translate as you go
Read it: the advert again, and work out what two books cost at the weekend

Read this

shū, shí yuán yì běn běnzi, liǎng yuán yì běn dà báicài, sān yuán shuǐ, yì yuán shǒujī, jiǔbǎi jiǔshíjiǔ yuán

xīngqīliù hé xīngqītiān liǎng běn shū shíwǔ yuán

A price list puts the thing first and its price after, with 一本 for each one where the thing is counted by the book. 一 falls before the rise of yuán: *yì yuán*, as before běn. The advert changes only one thing: the price at the weekend.

Your turn

- What do two books cost on Saturday? (**Fifteen yuan:** 两本书十五元, said *shíwǔ kuài*.)
- What do a book and a notebook cost together? (**Twelve yuan**, said *shí'èr kuài*.)

- Which costs one yuan? (**The water:** 水 一元.)
- *Say it:* the price list aloud, once, saying *kuài* for each 元

Before you move on

What is the dearest thing on the list? (手机, 999 yuan.) What does a notebook cost? (两元, said *liǎng kuài*.) Which days does the advert cover? (星期六和星期天.)

156.7 一本书十元

The chapter closes here, at the counter, asking about the list you have read.

- *Recall:* say 水 一元 — *shuǐ, yì yuán* — **R1**, the reading
- *Recall:* say *miǎnfèi*, free — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *jiàqián*, price — **R2**

The exchange

A: *zhè běn shū duōshao qián* — How much is this book?

B: 一本书十元

yì běn shū shí yuán — Ten yuan a book.

A: *jiàqián tài guì le* — That's too dear.

B: 星期六和星期天 两本书十五元

xīngqīliù hé xīngqītiān, liǎng běn shū shíwǔ yuán — At the weekend, two books for fifteen.

A: *nǐ kàndào guǎnggào le ma* — Did you see the advert?

B: *kàndào le, shuǐ miǎnfèi* — Yes, and the water's free.

A: 本子呢

běnzi ne — And notebooks?

B: 两元一本

liǎng yuán yì běn — Two yuan each.

The list says 元 and the speakers read it as written; at a counter, most people would say *kuài*. Both are right.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — reading prices, saying prices

Written in 元, said in *kuài*:

- 一本书十元 *yì běn shū shí yuán* — said *yì běn shū shí kuài.*
- 两本书十五元 *liǎng běn shū shíwǔ yuán* — two books, fifteen yuan.
- *jiàqián tài guì le* — the price is too high.

Listen. *Yí ge shǒujī duōshao qián?*
Speak. Read three prices from a list you know, saying *kuài* each time.
Write it: 十元 — 元 is 二 over 儿

Your turn

- *Say it: zhè běn shū duōshao qián* — How much is this book?
- *Say it:* 一本书十元 — *yì běn shū shí yuán* — Ten yuan a book.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 一本书十元

Before you move on

Read ten yuan as written. (十元.) Say it as people do. (*shí kuài.*) Say the water is free. (*shuǐ miǎnfèi.*)

Chapter 157

A Note About Tomorrow

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (2) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can understand a notice and a message, and write a connected reply.
>
> *Complete ZH-R157-review-final-157: one dialogue across the A2 core, after reading a notice at work and a friend's message and writing a connected reply of four to six lines.*

157.1 开会 (kāihuì) — to have a meeting

A new chapter, and it opens on a word you will hear at work.

- *Recall:* say 一本书十元 — *yì běn shū shí yuán* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *guǎnggào*, an advert — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 开门 — *kāimén*, to open — **R2**

You'll want to know: 开会

开会 — *kāihuì* — "to have a meeting".

> 明天下午开会 *míngtiān xiàwǔ kāihuì* — There's a meeting tomorrow afternoon.
>
> 我们在开会 *wǒmen zài kāihuì* — We're in a meeting.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开会 (*kāihuì*) is built from 开 'to open' and 会 'a gathering'. 会 is the character of 会 'can' and 会 'will', inherited from Middle Chinese *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to come together': here it keeps that sense.

What you've built

开 starts many things you know: 开门, 开车, and now 开会.
在 before it says the meeting is going on: 我们在开会.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāihuì*
- *Say it: kāihuì*, once more
- *Say it:* 明天下午开会 — *míngtiān xiàwǔ kāihuì* — There's a meeting tomorrow afternoon.
- *Say it:* 我们在开会 — *wǒmen zài kāihuì* — We're in a meeting.
- *Recall:* say 开门 and 开车, then 开会

Before you move on

What does 开会 mean? ("To have a meeting".) Say there's a meeting tomorrow afternoon. (明天下午开会.)

157.2 tōngzhī — to notify; a notice

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a word that ends the same way.

- *Recall:* say 开会 — *kāihuì* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *zhīdào*, to know — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: tōngzhī

tōngzhī — "to notify; a notice".

> *lǎoshī tōngzhī wǒmen míngtiān kāihuì* — The teacher let us know there's a meeting tomorrow.
>
> *zhè shì yí ge tōngzhī* — This is a notice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tōngzhī is built from tōng 'to get through' and zhī 'to know', the zhī of *zhīdào*. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *thuwng* and *trje* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to reach' and 'to perceive': making something known.

What you've built

As a verb, *tōngzhī* takes the people told, then the news: *tōngzhī wǒmen míngtiān kāihuì*.
As a noun it is the notice itself, pinned up or sent round.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōngzhī*
- *Say it: tōngzhī*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī tōngzhī wǒmen míngtiān kāihuì* — The teacher let us know there's a meeting tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say *zhīdào*, then *tōngzhī*

Before you move on

What does *tōngzhī* mean? ("To notify; a notice".) What comes after it as a verb? (**Who is told, then the news**.)

157.3 xiāoxi — news; a message

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then a word that ends on the same light xi.

- *Recall:* say *tōngzhī*, a notice — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *xiūxi*, to rest — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: xiāoxi

xiāoxi — "news; a message".

wǒ yǒu yí ge hǎo xiāoxi — I've got some good news.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāoxi is built from xiāo and xi, the xi of *xiūxi*. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjew* and *sik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to melt away; to wane' and 'to stop; to breed'. Neither gloss gives 'news', so how the pair came to mean it is not settled.

What you've built

xiāoxi is any news, and the message that brings it: a text from a friend is a *xiāoxi*.
The xi at the end is light, as in *xiūxi*.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāoxi*
- *Say it: xiāoxi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒu yí ge hǎo xiāoxi* — I've got some good news.
- *Recall:* say *xiūxi*, then *xiāoxi*

Before you move on

What does *xiāoxi* mean? ("News; a message".) Say you have some good news. (*wǒ yǒu yí ge hǎo xiāoxi*.)

157.4 huífù — to reply

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two words this one leans on.

- *Recall:* say *xiāoxi*, a message — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *huídá*, to answer — **R2**, a few chapters back
- *Recall:* say *fùxí*, to revise — **R2**

You'll want to know: huífù

huífù — "to reply (to a message)".

qǐng huífù — Please reply.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huífù is built from *huí* 'to go back' and fù 'to return', the fù of *fùxí*. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *bjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to turn round' and 'to return'. The regular change from *bjuwk* gives fú; fù continues the Guangyun's other reading, *bjuwH*, glossed 'again'.

What you've built

huídá answers a question; *huífù* answers a message.
请 in front makes it the polite request at the foot of a notice: *qǐng huífù*.

Your turn

- *Say it: huífù*
- *Say it: huífù*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng huífù* — Please reply.
- *Recall:* say *huídá*, then *huífù*: a question, then a message

Before you move on

What does *huífù* mean? ("To reply to a message".) And *huídá*? (**To answer a question**.)

157.5 (reading) — a notice and a message

A notice pinned up at work, then a message from a friend.

- *Recall:* say *huífù*, to reply — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *tōngzhī*, a notice — **R2**

大家

Read it: it aloud, with nothing said first — *dàjiā*

Read this

明天下午三点开会 大家都要来 请不要来晚了

我明天不能去了 因为我妈妈病了 后天下午你在家吗 我想两点来看你 给我打电话

Read it: the notice and the message through once without stopping; do not translate as you go
Read it: the message again, and find the question your friend asks you

Read this

míngtiān xiàwǔ sān diǎn kāihuì dàjiā dōu yào lái qǐng bú yào lái wǎn le

wǒ míngtiān bù néng qù le yīnwèi wǒ māma bìng le hòutiān xiàwǔ nǐ zài jiā ma wǒ xiǎng liǎng diǎn lái kàn nǐ gěi wǒ dǎ diànhuà

The notice speaks to everyone, 大家, and asks with 请. The message runs in order: what has changed, why, a question, an offer, a request. 因为 ties the reason to the line before it.

Your turn

- When is the meeting? (明天下午三点: three tomorrow afternoon.)
- Why isn't your friend coming tomorrow? (因为我妈妈病了: the mother is ill.)
- What does your friend ask you? (后天下午你在家吗: whether you are home the afternoon after tomorrow.)
- What does your friend want you to do? (给我打电话: phone back.)
- *Say it:* the message aloud, once, as your friend would say it

Before you move on

Who is the notice for? (大家: everyone.) What must nobody be? (来晚了: late.) What time does your friend want to come? (两点.)

157.6 A reply, and the lines that lean on each other

The last lesson ended on a message from a friend: they cannot come tomorrow, and they ask whether you are at home the afternoon after.

This lesson answers it.

- *Recall:* say *huífù*, to reply

What to know first

Connected writing is not **longer** writing. Four short lines can hang together; six long ones can fall apart. What makes lines connected is that each one leans on the one before it.

Three things do the leaning, and you own all three. **A time word at the front** of a line tells your reader where in the day they are: 后天下午, 两点以后. **The subject said once**: say 我 in the first line, and the lines after it can start on the time or the verb. 因为 ties a reason to the line before it, so your reader knows why.

Your reader is the friend who sent the message. Your purpose is to settle the appointment: answer the question, then agree a time.

Writing — connected composition

Write **four to six lines** back to your friend. No name at the top: write to them as you would in a message.

- Line 1 answers the question: 后天下午我在家, or 后天下午我不在家.
- Line 2 says what you will be doing then, with 会, 要 or 正在.
- Line 3 gives one reason, with 因为.
- Line 4 offers a time, with 从 … 到 …, or 两点以后.
- The last line asks after their mother. 你妈妈 … needs only characters you write.

A word whose characters you have not written goes in pinyin, inside the line, with its tone marks: *kěyǐ*, *shūfu*, *huífù*. Every character comes from the 163 you have learned, each in the order you learned it, each in the same size of square.

No Chinese commas or full stops: leave a space between clauses, as this book prints them.

Write the reply. Then read it once as your friend would, top to bottom.

Before you move on

Read your third line on its own. Does it stand up without the line above it? (**It should not quite: 因为 leans on the line before**.) Count the lines that start with 我. If every one does, you wrote a list, not a reply.

157.7 The A2 core — once more

The last lesson of the A2 core: one conversation that uses every chapter of it.

- *Recall:* say *xiāoxi*, a message — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 开门 and *guānmén*, to open and to close — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *jiàqián* and *miǎnfèi*, the price and free — **R2**

Your turn

A: 明天会下雨吗

míngtiān huì xiàyǔ ma — Will it rain tomorrow?

B: *tiānqì yùbào shuō kěnéng huì* — The forecast says it might.

B: 后天不会

hòutiān bú huì — Not the day after.

A: 后天下午开会 你来吗

hòutiān xiàwǔ kāihuì, nǐ lái ma — There's a meeting the afternoon after tomorrow. Are you coming?

B: *wǒ yídìng lái* — I'll be there, for sure.

A: 从两点到四点

cóng liǎng diǎn dào sì diǎn — From two till four.

B: *nǐ kàndào tōngzhī le ma* — Did you see the notice?

A: *kàndào le, wǒ yě huífù le* — I saw it, and I've replied.

B: 下个月你要去中国吗

xià ge yuè nǐ yào qù Zhōngguó ma — Are you going to China next month?

A: 要

yào — I am.

A: 你去过中国吗

nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma — Have you ever been?

B: 没去过

méi qù guo — No, never.

B: 你汉语说得很好

nǐ Hànyǔ shuō de hěn hǎo — Your Chinese is good.

A: 我没有他那么好

wǒ méiyǒu tā nàme hǎo — Not as good as his.

B: 你要水还是要饭

nǐ yào shuǐ háishi yào fàn — Water or food?

A: 饭 我还没吃

fàn, wǒ hái méi chī — Food. I haven't eaten yet.

B: 我正在做饭

wǒ zhèngzài zuò fàn — I'm cooking right now.

B: *bié zǒu* — Don't go.

A: *wǒ de huǒchē bā diǎn chūfā* — My train leaves at eight.

A: *wǒ kàndào yí ge guǎnggào* — I saw an advert:

A: 书十元一本

shū shí yuán yì běn — books at ten yuan each.

B: 星期天不开门

xīngqītiān bù kāimén — That shop is closed on Sundays.

- *Read it:* the lines printed in characters aloud, then the rest
- *Say it:* the whole dialogue, both parts
- *Say it:* B's lines again, with your own answers

Before you move on

Will? (会.) Going to? (要.) Right now? (正在.) Ever? (过.) Saw it? (看到.) How well? (得.) Than? (比.) Or? (还是.) Not yet? (还没.) From … to? (从 **...** 到.) Yuan, as written? (元.) A meeting? (开会.) Reply? (*huífù*.)

Chapter 158

Waking Up

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who wakes me, when I fall asleep, what I dream and what I am used to.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say who wakes me, when I fall asleep, what I dream and what I am used to.*

158.1 jiàoxǐng — to wake someone up

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for news, then the Mandarin for to reply.

You'll want to know: jiàoxǐng

jiàoxǐng — "to wake someone up".

> *māma měitiān qī diǎn jiàoxǐng wǒ* — Mum wakes me at seven every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàoxǐng is built from 叫 'to call' and *xǐng* 'to wake', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kewH* and *sengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second as sobering up after wine: to call someone awake.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàoxǐng*
- *Say it: jiàoxǐng*, once more
- *Say it: māma měitiān qī diǎn jiàoxǐng wǒ* — Mum wakes me at seven every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for news, then the Mandarin for to reply, then say *jiàoxǐng* again

Before you move on

What does jiàoxǐng mean? ("To wake someone up".) Say it once more.

158.2 shuìzháo — to fall asleep

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to reply, then the Mandarin for to wake someone up.

You'll want to know: shuìzháo

shuìzháo — "to fall asleep".

wǒ zuótiān wǎnshang shí'èr diǎn shuìzháo le — Last night I fell asleep at twelve.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuìzháo is built from *shuì* 'to sleep' and *zháo*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyweH* and *drjak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'to attach to': sleep takes hold.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuìzháo*
- *Say it: shuìzháo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuótiān wǎnshang shí'èr diǎn shuìzháo le* — Last night I fell asleep at twelve.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to reply, then the Mandarin for to wake someone up, then say *shuìzháo* again

Before you move on

What does shuìzháo mean? ("To fall asleep".) Say it once more.

158.3 zuòmèng — to dream; to have a dream

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wake someone up, then the Mandarin for to fall asleep.

You'll want to know: zuòmèng

zuòmèng — "to dream; to have a dream".

wǒ chángcháng zuòmèng — I dream a lot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuòmèng is built from 做 'to do' and *mèng* 'a dream'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as the spirit wandering in sleep; 做 has no form in that dictionary, so the history of the first part is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòmèng*
- *Say it: zuòmèng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chángcháng zuòmèng* — I dream a lot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wake someone up, then the Mandarin for to fall asleep, then say *zuòmèng* again

Before you move on

What does zuòmèng mean? ("To dream; to have a dream".) Say it once more.

158.4 起来 (qǐlai) — to get up; to stand up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fall asleep, then the Mandarin for to have a dream.

You'll want to know: 起来

起来 — *qǐlai* — "to get up; to stand up".

七点了你快起来 *qī diǎn le nǐ kuài qǐlai* — It's seven o'clock: up you get, quick.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

起来 (*qǐlai*) is built from 起 'to rise' and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khiX* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and 'to stand'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐlai*
- *Say it: qǐlai*, once more
- *Say it: qī diǎn le nǐ kuài qǐlai* — It's seven o'clock: up you get, quick.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fall asleep, then the Mandarin for to have a dream, then say *qǐlai* again

Before you move on

What does 起来 mean? ("To get up; to stand up".) Say it once more.

158.5 xíguàn — to be used to; a habit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a dream, then the Mandarin for to stand up.

You'll want to know: xíguàn

xíguàn — "to be used to; a habit".

wǒ hái méi xíguàn liù diǎn qǐchuáng — I'm still not used to getting up at six.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xíguàn is built from *xí* and *guàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zip* and *kwaenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to learn' and explains the second with the first: practised.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xíguàn*
- *Say it: xíguàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hái méi xíguàn liù diǎn qǐchuáng* — I'm still not used to getting up at six.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a dream, then the Mandarin for to stand up, then say *xíguàn* again

Before you move on

What does xíguàn mean? ("To be used to; a habit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

Rooms at Home

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the bedroom, the living room, the study, the balcony and the window.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can name the bedroom, the living room, the study, the balcony and the window.*

159.1 wòshì — bedroom

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stand up, then the Mandarin for to be used to.

You'll want to know: wòshì

wòshì — "bedroom".

> *wǒ de wòshì hěn xiǎo* — My bedroom is small.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wòshì is built from *wò* 'to lie down' and *shì* 'room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwaH* and *syit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a room to lie down in.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: wòshì*
- *Say it: wòshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de wòshì hěn xiǎo* — My bedroom is small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stand up, then the Mandarin for to be used to, then say *wòshì* again

Before you move on

What does wòshì mean? ("Bedroom".) Say it once more.

159.2 kètīng — living room; sitting room

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be used to, then the Mandarin for a bedroom.

You'll want to know: kètīng

kètīng — "living room; sitting room".

kèrén zài kètīng — The guests are in the living room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kètīng is built from 客 'guest' and *tīng* 'hall'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the second is listed there as *theng*, glossed 'a hall', a different word from the *tīng* of listening: the hall for guests.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: kètīng*
- *Say it: kètīng*, once more
- *Say it: kèrén zài kètīng* — The guests are in the living room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be used to, then the Mandarin for a bedroom, then say *kètīng* again

Before you move on

What does kètīng mean? ("Living room; sitting room".) Say it once more.

159.3 书房 (shūfáng) — study; a room for books and work

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bedroom, then the Mandarin for a living room.

You'll want to know: 书房

书房 — *shūfáng* — "study; a room for books and work".

我的书都在书房里 *wǒ de shū dōu zài shūfáng lǐ* — All my books are in the study.

The new character, in pieces: 房 — eight strokes in two pieces: on top a door of four strokes (a dot, a horizontal that turns down, a horizontal closing it, a long stroke falling to the left), and under it the four strokes of the piece read fāng. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

书房 (*shūfáng*) is built from 书 'book' and 房 'room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syo* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a room': the room for books.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūfáng*
- *Say it: shūfáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shū dōu zài shūfáng lǐ* — All my books are in the study.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bedroom, then the Mandarin for a living room, then say *shūfáng* again

Before you move on

What does 书房 mean? ("Study; a room for books and work".) Say it once more.

159.4 房 — a door over fáng

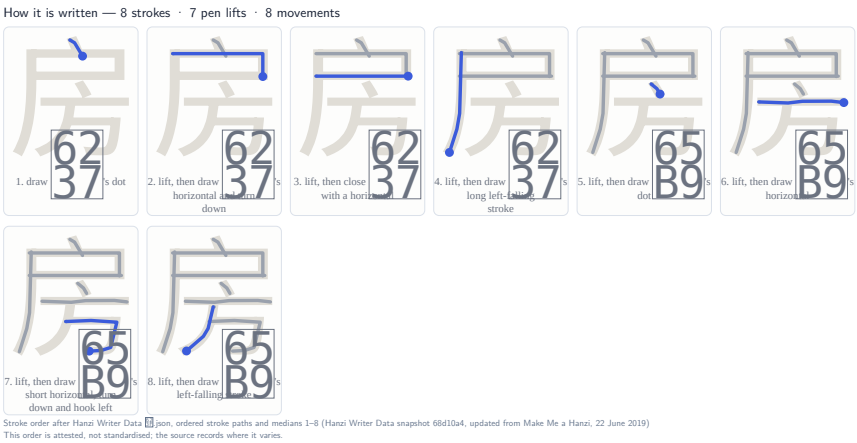
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shūfáng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  书 门

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shū*, *mén*

Script — a door over fāng



How 房 is written, stroke by stroke

房

Two pieces, top over bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The door, four strokes. A dot on top. A horizontal that turns down at its right end. A horizontal under it, closing the box. Then a long stroke from the top left falling down to the lower left: the side of the door.

The piece read fāng, four strokes, under the door. A dot. A long horizontal. A horizontal that turns down and hooks back to the left. Last, a stroke falling to the left through the middle.

4 + 4 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 房, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 房? (**Eight**.) Which piece is on top? (**The door, four strokes**.) Which stroke of the lower piece hooks? (**The third, the one that turns down**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 房, pinned stroke paths and medians.

159.5 yángtái — balcony

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a living room, then the Mandarin for a study at home.

You'll want to know: yángtái

yángtái — "balcony".

wǒmen jiā de yángtái hěn dà — Our balcony is big.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yángtái is built from *yáng* 'the sunny side' and a word for a platform, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yang* and *doj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary writes the second another way and glosses it as raised square ground: a platform in the sun.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yángtái*
- *Say it: yángtái*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiā de yángtái hěn dà* — Our balcony is big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a living room, then the Mandarin for a study at home, then say *yángtái* again

Before you move on

What does yángtái mean? ("Balcony".) Say it once more.

159.6 chuānghu — window

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a study at home, then the Mandarin for a balcony.

You'll want to know: chuānghu

chuānghu — "window".

wòshì de chuānghu hěn dà — The bedroom window is big.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuānghu is built from *chuāng* 'window' and *hu* 'door', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhaewng* and *huX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary writes the first another way and glosses it 'an opening right through'; it calls the second half of a door. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuānghu*
- *Say it: chuānghu*, once more
- *Say it: wòshì de chuānghu hěn dà* — The bedroom window is big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a study at home, then the Mandarin for a balcony, then say *chuānghu* again

Before you move on

What does chuānghu mean? ("Window".) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

Doing the Chores

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about sweeping, washing up, making the bed, doing jobs and looking after someone.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can talk about sweeping, washing up, making the bed, doing jobs and looking after someone.*

160.1 sǎodì — to sweep the floor

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a balcony, then the Mandarin for a window.

You'll want to know: sǎodì

sǎodì — "to sweep the floor".

> *wǒ sǎodì nǐ xǐ cài* — I'll sweep the floor; you wash the vegetables.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sǎodì is built from 扫 'to sweep' and *dì* 'ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sawX* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǎodì*
- *Say it: sǎodì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ sǎodì nǐ xǐ cài* — I'll sweep the floor; you wash the vegetables.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a balcony, then the Mandarin for a window, then say *sǎodì* again

Before you move on

What does sǎodì mean? ("To sweep the floor".) Say it once more.

160.2 xǐwǎn — to do the washing-up; to wash the dishes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a window, then the Mandarin for to sweep the floor.

You'll want to know: xǐwǎn

xǐwǎn — "to do the washing-up; to wash the dishes".

chī fàn yǐhòu wǒ xǐwǎn — After we eat, I'll do the dishes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: xǐwǎn is said xíwǎn, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐwǎn is built from 洗 'to wash' and *wǎn* 'bowl', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejX* and *'wanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which writes the second another way and glosses it 'a vessel'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐwǎn*
- *Say it: xǐwǎn*, once more
- *Say it: chī fàn yǐhòu wǒ xǐwǎn* — After we eat, I'll do the dishes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a window, then the Mandarin for to sweep the floor, then say *xǐwǎn* again

Before you move on

What does xǐwǎn mean? ("To do the washing-up; to wash the dishes".) Say it once more.

160.3 pūchuáng — to make the bed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sweep the floor, then the Mandarin for to do the washing-up.

You'll want to know: pūchuáng

pūchuáng — "to make the bed".

qǐchuáng yǐhòu bié wàng le pūchuáng — Don't forget to make your bed when you get up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pūchuáng is built from *pū* 'to spread out' and *chuáng* 'bed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phu* and *dzrjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to spread the bedding out.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: pūchuáng*
- *Say it: pūchuáng*, once more
- *Say it: qǐchuáng yǐhòu bié wàng le pūchuáng* — Don't forget to make your bed when you get up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sweep the floor, then the Mandarin for to do the washing-up, then say *pūchuáng* again

Before you move on

What does pūchuáng mean? ("To make the bed".) Say it once more.

160.4 gànhuó — to get the jobs done; to work

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to do the washing-up, then the Mandarin for to make the bed.

You'll want to know: gànhuó

gànhuó — "to get the jobs done; to work".

nǐmen dōu zài gànhuó ma — Are you all busy working?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gànhuó is built from *gàn* and *huó*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kanH* and *hwat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a stem' and 'strong' and the second 'alive'; how the pair came to mean doing the work is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: gànhuó*
- *Say it: gànhuó*, once more
- *Say it: nǐmen dōu zài gànhuó ma* — Are you all busy working?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to do the washing-up, then the Mandarin for to make the bed, then say *gànhuó* again

Before you move on

What does gànhuó mean? ("To get the jobs done; to work".) Say it once more.

160.5 zhàogù — to look after; to take care of

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make the bed, then the Mandarin for to get the jobs done.

You'll want to know: zhàogù

zhàogù — "to look after; to take care of".

māma bìng le wǒ yào zhàogù tā — Mum is ill, so I'm going to look after her.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhàogù is built from *zhào* 'bright, to shine' and *gù* 'to turn and look'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the second is listed there as *kuH*, glossed 'to look back' and 'to care for'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhàogù*
- *Say it: zhàogù*, once more
- *Say it: māma bìng le wǒ yào zhàogù tā* — Mum is ill, so I'm going to look after her.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make the bed, then the Mandarin for to get the jobs done, then say *zhàogù* again

Before you move on

What does zhàogù mean? ("To look after; to take care of".) Say it once more.

Chapter 161

Rice and Meat

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for rice, a portion, fried rice, beef and chicken.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can ask for rice, a portion, fried rice, beef and chicken.*

161.1 大米 (dàmǐ) — uncooked rice; rice grain

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get the jobs done, then the Mandarin for to look after.

You'll want to know: 大米

大米 — *dàmǐ* — "uncooked rice; rice grain".

> 我去买大米 *wǒ qù mǎi dàmǐ* — I'm going to buy rice.

The new character, in pieces: 米 — six strokes: two short strokes slanting in toward the middle, a horizontal, a vertical through it, then from the crossing a stroke falling to the left and one falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大米 (*dàmǐ*) is built from 大 'big' and 米 'grain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *mejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription),

which glosses the second as the seed of a cereal.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàmǐ*
- *Say it: dàmǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù mǎi dàmǐ* — I'm going to buy rice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get the jobs done, then the Mandarin for to look after, then say *dàmǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 大米 mean? ("Uncooked rice; rice grain".) Say it once more.

161.2 米 — a cross with two strokes above and two below

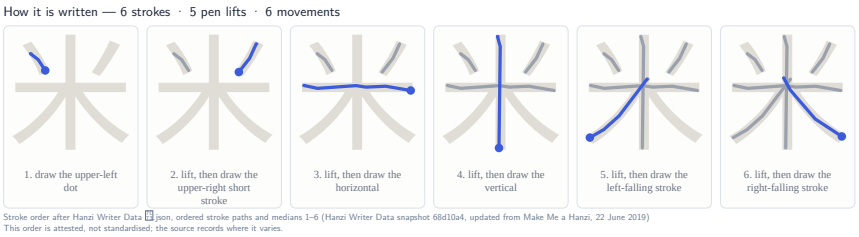
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dàmǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  来 大

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lái*, *dà*

Script — a cross with two strokes above and two below



How 米 is written, stroke by stroke

米

One piece, six strokes, built round a cross.

Two short strokes first, slanting in toward the middle: a dot from the upper left, then a short stroke from the upper right falling to the left.

The cross. A long horizontal, then a vertical down through its middle.

The legs, from the crossing. A stroke falling to the lower left, then one falling to the lower right.

2 + 2 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 米, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 米? (**Six**.) Which two come first? (**The two short strokes above the cross**.) Which come last? (**The two legs, left, then right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 米, pinned stroke paths and medians.

161.3 fèn — measure word for a serving; portion

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look after, then the Mandarin for uncooked rice.

You'll want to know: fèn

fèn — "measure word for a serving; portion".

wǒ yào liǎng fèn mǐfàn — Two portions of rice, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fèn has no older form of this word in any dictionary we use: the Guangyun lists the character only as *pin*, glossed 'refined', which is neither this sound nor this sense. Its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: fèn*
- *Say it: fèn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào liǎng fèn mǐfàn* — Two portions of rice, please.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look after, then the Mandarin for uncooked rice, then say *fèn* again

Before you move on

What does fèn mean? ("Measure word for a serving; portion".) Say it once more.

161.4 chǎofàn — fried rice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for uncooked rice, then the Mandarin for measure word for a serving.

You'll want to know: chǎofàn

chǎofàn — "fried rice".

> *tā yào le yí fèn chǎofàn* — He ordered a portion of fried rice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǎofàn is built from *chǎo* 'to stir-fry' and 饭 'cooked rice', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhaewX* and *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to roast dry'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǎofàn*
- *Say it: chǎofàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā yào le yí fèn chǎofàn* — He ordered a portion of fried rice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for uncooked rice, then the Mandarin for measure word for a serving, then say *chǎofàn* again

Before you move on

What does chǎofàn mean? ("Fried rice".) Say it once more.

161.5 niúròu — beef

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for measure word for a serving, then the Mandarin for fried rice.

You'll want to know: niúròu

niúròu — "beef".

> *zhège niúròu hěn hǎochī* — This beef is delicious.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niúròu is built from *niú* 'ox' and *ròu* 'meat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjuw* and *nyuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: niúròu*
- *Say it: niúròu*, once more
- *Say it: zhège niúròu hěn hǎochī* — This beef is delicious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for measure word for a serving, then the Mandarin for fried rice, then say *niúròu* again

Before you move on

What does niúròu mean? ("Beef".) Say it once more.

161.6 jīròu — chicken meat; chicken (as food)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fried rice, then the Mandarin for beef.

You'll want to know: jīròu

jīròu — "chicken meat; chicken (as food)".

nǐ yào niúròu háishi jīròu — Would you like beef or chicken?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīròu is built from *jī* 'chicken' and *ròu* 'meat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kej* and *nyuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription);

the dictionary quotes an older book calling the first the creature that knows the hour.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīròu*
- *Say it: jīròu*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yào niúròu háishi jīròu* — Would you like beef or chicken?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fried rice, then the Mandarin for beef, then say *jīròu* again

Before you move on

What does jīròu mean? ("Chicken meat; chicken (as food)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 162

How Often

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I do as a rule, every time, regularly, now and then and normally.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say what I do as a rule, every time, regularly, now and then and normally.*

162.1 yìbān — generally; as a rule; ordinary

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for beef, then the Mandarin for chicken meat.

You'll want to know: yìbān

yìbān — "generally; as a rule; ordinary".

> *wǒ yìbān qī diǎn qǐchuáng* — As a rule I get up at seven.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
The tone of 一 changes: yī is said yì before the first tone of bān.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìbān is built from 一 'one' and *bān* 'kind'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the second is listed there as *pan*, glossed 'to carry', and as *ban*, glossed 'joy'. The sense 'kind' is not given, so how the pair came to mean 'as a rule' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìbān*
- *Say it: yìbān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yìbān qī diǎn qǐchuáng* — As a rule I get up at seven.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for beef, then the Mandarin for chicken meat, then say *yìbān* again

Before you move on

What does yìbān mean? ("Generally; as a rule; ordinary".) Say it once more.

162.2 zǒngshì — every single time; always

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for chicken meat, then the Mandarin for as a rule.

You'll want to know: zǒngshì

zǒngshì — "every single time; always".

tā zǒngshì hěn máng — He's busy all the time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zǒngshì is built from *zǒng* 'all, gathered together' and 是 'to be', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsuwngX* and *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); how the pair came to mean every time is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǒngshì*
- *Say it: zǒngshì*, once more
- *Say it: tā zǒngshì hěn máng* — He's busy all the time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for chicken meat, then the Mandarin for as a rule, then say *zǒngshì* again

Before you move on

What does zǒngshì mean? ("Every single time; always".) Say it once more.

162.3 jīngcháng — regularly; often

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as a rule, then the Mandarin for every single time.

You'll want to know: jīngcháng

jīngcháng — "regularly; often".

wǒ jīngcháng qù Běijīng — I go to Beijing regularly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīngcháng is built from *jīng* and *cháng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keng* and *dzyang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'constant', using the second as its gloss; the sense 'often' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīngcháng*
- *Say it: jīngcháng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jīngcháng qù Běijīng* — I go to Beijing regularly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as a rule, then the Mandarin for every single time, then say *jīngcháng* again

Before you move on

What does jīngcháng mean? ("Regularly; often".) Say it once more.

162.4 ǒu'ěr — now and then; occasionally

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for every single time, then the Mandarin for regularly.

You'll want to know: ǒu'ěr

ǒu'ěr — "now and then; occasionally".

wǒ ǒu'ěr hē kāfēi — I drink coffee now and then.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: ǒu'ěr is said óu'ěr, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ǒu'ěr is built from *ǒu* 'by chance' and the old ending 尔, both inherited from Middle Chinese (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the first as *nguwH*, glossed 'unexpected', though today's third tone goes with its other reading, *nguwX* 'a pair'; the second as *nyeX*, glossed 'you', here an ending.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: ǒu'ěr*
- *Say it: ǒu'ěr*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ ǒu'ěr hē kāfēi* — I drink coffee now and then.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for every single time, then the Mandarin for regularly, then say *ǒu'ěr* again

Before you move on

What does ǒu'ěr mean? ("Now and then; occasionally".) Say it once more.

162.5 tōngcháng — normally; usually

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for regularly, then the Mandarin for now and then.

You'll want to know: tōngcháng

tōngcháng — "normally; usually".

zhōumò wǒ tōngcháng zài jiā — At weekends I'm normally at home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tōngcháng is built from *tōng* 'to go through' and *cháng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thuwng* and *dzyang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): what holds right through. The sense 'normal' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōngcháng*
- *Say it: tōngcháng*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒ tōngcháng zài jiā* — At weekends I'm normally at home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for regularly, then the Mandarin for now and then, then say *tōngcháng* again

Before you move on

What does tōngcháng mean? ("Normally; usually".) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

Free This Weekend

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask if someone is free, go with them, plan a picnic and put it off until next time.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can ask if someone is free, go with them, plan a picnic and put it off until next time.*

163.1 yǒukòng — to have free time; to be free

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for now and then, then the Mandarin for normally.

You'll want to know: yǒukòng

yǒukòng — "to have free time; to be free".

> *nǐ zhōumò yǒukòng ma* — Are you free at the weekend?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒukòng is built from 有 'to have' and *kòng* 'a gap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *khuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a gap'. It is the falling-tone partner of *kōng* 'empty': to have a gap in the day.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒukòng*
- *Say it: yǒukòng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zhōumò yǒukòng ma* — Are you free at the weekend?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for now and then, then the Mandarin for normally, then say *yǒukòng* again

Before you move on

What does yǒukòng mean? ("To have free time; to be free".) Say it once more.

163.2 péi — to keep someone company; to go along with

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for normally, then the Mandarin for to have free time.

You'll want to know: péi

péi — "to keep someone company; to go along with".

zhōumò wǒ péi māma qù mǎi dōngxi — At the weekend I'm going shopping with my mum.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

péi is inherited from Middle Chinese *bwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to attend at someone's side'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: péi*
- *Say it: péi*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒ péi māma qù mǎi dōngxi* — At the weekend I'm going shopping with my mum.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for normally, then the Mandarin for to have free time, then say *péi* again

Before you move on

What does péi mean? ("To keep someone company; to go along with".) Say it once more.

163.3 yěcān — to have a picnic; a picnic

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have free time, then the Mandarin for to keep someone company.

You'll want to know: yěcān

yěcān — "to have a picnic; a picnic".

zhōumò wǒmen qù gōngyuán yěcān — This weekend we're going to the park for a picnic.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yěcān is built from *yě* 'open country' and *cān* 'meal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yaeX* and *tshan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second 'to swallow'. A meal out in the fields.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yěcān*
- *Say it: yěcān*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen qù gōngyuán yěcān* — This weekend we're going to the park for a picnic.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have free time, then the Mandarin for to keep someone company, then say *yěcān* again

Before you move on

What does yěcān mean? ("To have a picnic; a picnic".) Say it once more.

163.4 xià cì — next time

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep someone company, then the Mandarin for to have a picnic.

You'll want to know: xià cì

xià cì — "next time".

jīntiān wǒ méiyǒu kòng xià cì wǒmen yìqǐ qù — I'm busy today; let's go together next time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xià cì is built from 下 'below, next' and *cì* 'a turn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *tshijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'order, sequence': the next turn.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: xià cì*
- *Say it: xià cì*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒ méiyǒu kòng xià cì wǒmen yìqǐ qù* — I'm busy today; let's go together next time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep someone company, then the Mandarin for to have a picnic, then say *xià cì* again

Before you move on

What does xià cì mean? ("Next time".) Say it once more.

163.5 yíkuàir — all together; together (in everyday speech)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a picnic, then the Mandarin for next time.

You'll want to know: yíkuàir

yíkuàir — "all together; together (in everyday speech)".

wǒmen yíkuàir qù yěcān — Let's all go for the picnic together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
The tone of 一 changes: yī is said yí before the fourth tone of kuài.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yíkuàir is built from 一 'one', *kuài* 'a lump' and the ending 儿, all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit*, *khwojH* and *nye* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'a clod of earth': in one lump.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíkuàir*
- *Say it: yíkuàir*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yíkuàir qù yěcān* — Let's all go for the picnic together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a picnic, then the Mandarin for next time, then say *yíkuàir* again

Before you move on

What does yíkuàir mean? ("All together; together (in everyday speech)".) Say it once more.

163.6 Looking back: from Waking Up to Free This Weekend

Say the Mandarin for to wake someone up and to fall asleep.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to wake someone up, to fall asleep, to have a dream, to stand up, to be used to
- *Say it:* a bedroom, a living room, a study at home, a balcony, a window
- *Say it:* to sweep the floor, to do the washing-up, to make the bed, to get the jobs done, to look after
- *Say it:* uncooked rice, measure word for a serving, fried rice, beef, chicken meat
- *Say it:* as a rule, every single time, regularly, now and then, normally
- *Say it:* to have free time, to keep someone company, to have a picnic, next time, all together

- *Read it:* 房 米 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To wake someone up? (*jiàoxǐng.*) To fall asleep? (*shuìzháo.*) To have a dream? (*zuòmèng.*) To stand up? (起来, *qǐlai.*) To be used to? (*xíguàn.*) A bedroom? (*wòshì.*) A living room? (*kètīng.*) A study at home? (书房, *shūfáng.*) A balcony? (*yángtái.*) A window? (*chuānghu.*) To sweep the floor? (*sǎodì.*) To do the washing-up? (*xǐwǎn.*) To make the bed? (*pūchuáng.*) To get the jobs done? (*gànhuó.*) To look after? (*zhàogù.*) Uncooked rice? (大米, *dàmǐ.*) Measure word for a serving? (*fèn.*) Fried rice? (*chǎofàn.*) Beef? (*niúròu.*) Chicken meat? (*jīròu.*) As a rule? (*yìbān.*) Every single time? (*zǒngshì.*) Regularly? (*jīngcháng.*) Now and then? (*ǒu'ěr.*) Normally? (*tōngcháng.*) To have free time? (*yǒukòng.*) To keep someone company? (*péi.*) To have a picnic? (*yěcān.*) Next time? (*xià cì.*) All together? (*yíkuàir.*)

Chapter 164

Getting Ready

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about dressing up, washing and drying my hair, make-up and shaving.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can talk about dressing up, washing and drying my hair, make-up and shaving.*

164.1 dǎban — to dress up; to get dressed up

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for next time, then the Mandarin for all together.

You'll want to know: dǎban

dǎban — "to dress up; to get dressed up".

> *tā zài dǎban wǒmen děng yíhuìr* — She's getting ready; let's wait a moment.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎban is built from 打 'to strike' and *ban*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *peanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second with this very word, 'to dress up'. Dǎ is not the sound *taengX* would regularly give, and in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎban*
- *Say it: dǎban*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài dǎban wǒmen děng yíhuìr* — She's getting ready; let's wait a moment.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for next time, then the Mandarin for all together, then say *dǎban* again

Before you move on

What does dǎban mean? ("To dress up; to get dressed up".) Say it once more.

164.2 xǐtóu — to wash one's hair

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all together, then the Mandarin for to dress up.

You'll want to know: xǐtóu

xǐtóu — "to wash one's hair".

wǒ měitiān zǎoshang xǐtóu — I wash my hair every morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐtóu is built from 洗 'to wash' and *tóu* 'head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejX* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐtóu*
- *Say it: xǐtóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān zǎoshang xǐtóu* — I wash my hair every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all together, then the Mandarin for to dress up, then say *xǐtóu* again

Before you move on

What does xǐtóu mean? ("To wash one's hair".) Say it once more.

164.3 chuīfēngjī — hair dryer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dress up, then the Mandarin for to wash one's hair.

You'll want to know: chuīfēngjī

chuīfēngjī — "hair dryer".

xǐtóu yǐhòu wǒ yòng chuīfēngjī — After washing my hair I use the hair dryer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuīfēngjī is built from *chuī* 'to blow', *fēng* 'wind' and 机 'machine'. The last two are inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwng* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the first is listed there as *tsyhwe*, glossed 'to breathe out': the machine that blows wind.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuīfēngjī*
- *Say it: chuīfēngjī*, once more
- *Say it: xǐtóu yǐhòu wǒ yòng chuīfēngjī* — After washing my hair I use the hair dryer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dress up, then the Mandarin for to wash one's hair, then say *chuīfēngjī* again

Before you move on

What does chuīfēngjī mean? ("Hair dryer".) Say it once more.

164.4 huàzhuāng — to put on make-up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wash one's hair, then the Mandarin for a hair dryer.

You'll want to know: huàzhuāng

huàzhuāng — "to put on make-up".

wǒ māma měi cì chūmén yǐqián dōu huàzhuāng — My mum puts on make-up every time before she goes out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huàzhuāng is built from *huà* 'to change' and *zhuāng* 'to adorn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwaeH* and *tsrjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàzhuāng*
- *Say it: huàzhuāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma měi cì chūmén yǐqián dōu huàzhuāng* — My mum puts on make-up every time before she goes out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wash one's hair, then the Mandarin for a hair dryer, then say *huàzhuāng* again

Before you move on

What does huàzhuāng mean? ("To put on make-up".) Say it once more.

164.5 guāliǎn — to have a shave; to shave one's face

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hair dryer, then the Mandarin for to put on make-up.

You'll want to know: guāliǎn

guāliǎn — "to have a shave; to shave one's face".

bàba měitiān zǎoshang guāliǎn — Dad shaves every morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guāliǎn is built from *guā* 'to scrape' and *liǎn* 'face'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *kwaet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to scrape and pare'; the dictionary glosses the second, *leamX*, as the name of a kind of stew, so how it came to mean face is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: guāliǎn*
- *Say it: guāliǎn*, once more
- *Say it: bàba měitiān zǎoshang guāliǎn* — Dad shaves every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hair dryer, then the Mandarin for to put on make-up, then say *guāliǎn* again

Before you move on

What does guāliǎn mean? ("To have a shave; to shave one's face".) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

Coats and Scarves

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a coat, a sweater, a skirt and a scarf, and count them.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can name a coat, a sweater, a skirt and a scarf, and count them.*

165.1 大衣 (dàyī) — overcoat; coat

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put on make-up, then the Mandarin for to have a shave.

You'll want to know: 大衣

大衣 — *dàyī* — "overcoat; coat".

> 我的大衣在哪儿 *wǒ de dàyī zài nǎr* — Where's my coat?

The new character, in pieces: 衣 — six strokes: a dot and a horizontal on top, then a long stroke falling to the left, a short vertical that flicks up to the right, a short stroke falling to the left, and a long stroke falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大衣 (*dàyī*) is built from 大 'big' and 衣 'garment', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *'j+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription),

which glosses the second as the garment of the upper body: the big garment over the rest.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàyī*
- *Say it: dàyī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de dàyī zài nǎr* — Where's my coat?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put on make-up, then the Mandarin for to have a shave, then say *dàyī* again

Before you move on

What does 大衣 mean? ("Overcoat; coat".) Say it once more.

165.2 衣 — a dot and a bar, then the body

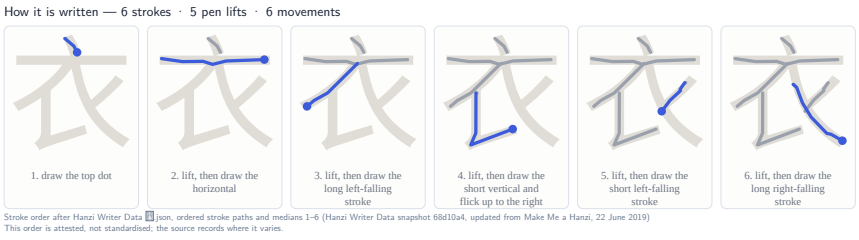
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dàyī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

大 上

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *shàng*

Script — a dot and a bar, then the body



How 衣 is written, stroke by stroke

衣

One piece, six strokes.

The top, two strokes. A dot. A long horizontal under it.

The body, four strokes. A long stroke falling to the lower left. A short vertical inside it that flicks up to the right at its foot. A short stroke on the right falling to the left. Last, a long stroke falling to the lower right.

2 + 4 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 衣, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 衣? (**Six**.) What comes first? (**A dot, then a horizontal**.) Which stroke flicks up? (**The short vertical inside the body**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 衣, pinned stroke paths and medians.

165.3 máoyī — sweater; jumper

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a shave, then the Mandarin for an overcoat.

You'll want to know: máoyī

máoyī — "sweater; jumper".

wǒ de máoyī hěn hǎokàn — My sweater looks nice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

máoyī is built from *máo* 'hair, wool' and 衣 'garment', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maw* and *'j+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the hair of brows and of beasts.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: máoyī*
- *Say it: máoyī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de máoyī hěn hǎokàn* — My sweater looks nice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a shave, then the Mandarin for an overcoat, then say *máoyī* again

Before you move on

What does máoyī mean? ("Sweater; jumper".) Say it once more.

165.4 tiáo — measure word for long things (skirts, scarves, trousers, fish, roads)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an overcoat, then the Mandarin for a sweater.

You'll want to know: tiáo

tiáo — "measure word for long things (skirts, scarves, trousers, fish, roads)".

wǒ mǎi le liǎng tiáo kùzi — I bought two pairs of trousers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiáo is inherited from Middle Chinese *dew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a small branch': a long, thin thing. Its use for counting is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiáo*
- *Say it: tiáo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎi le liǎng tiáo kùzi* — I bought two pairs of trousers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an overcoat, then the Mandarin for a sweater, then say *tiáo* again

Before you move on

What does tiáo mean? ("Measure word for long things (skirts, scarves, trousers, fish, roads)".) Say it once more.

165.5 qúnzi — skirt

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sweater, then the Mandarin for measure word for long things.

You'll want to know: qúnzi

qúnzi — "skirt".

zhè tiáo qúnzi hěn hǎokàn — This skirt looks nice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qúnzi is built from *qún* 'skirt' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjun* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which writes the first another way and glosses it as the garment of the lower body. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: qúnzi*
- *Say it: qúnzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhè tiáo qúnzi hěn hǎokàn* — This skirt looks nice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sweater, then the Mandarin for measure word for long things, then say *qúnzi* again

Before you move on

What does qúnzi mean? ("Skirt".) Say it once more.

165.6 wéijīn — scarf

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for measure word for long things, then the Mandarin for a skirt.

You'll want to know: wéijīn

wéijīn — "scarf".

wàibian hěn lěng nǐ yào dài yì tiáo wéijīn — It's cold outside, so take a scarf.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wéijīn is built from *wéi* 'to go round' and *jīn* 'a cloth'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *kin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the first is listed there as *hjw+j*, glossed 'to surround': a cloth that goes round the neck.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: wéijīn*
- *Say it: wéijīn*, once more
- *Say it: wàibian hěn lěng nǐ yào dài yì tiáo wéijīn* — It's cold outside, so take a scarf.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for measure word for long things, then the Mandarin for a skirt, then say *wéijīn* again

Before you move on

What does wéijīn mean? ("Scarf".) Say it once more.

Chapter 166

Tea Time

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for boiled water, afternoon tea, black tea and tea leaves, and make the tea.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can ask for boiled water, afternoon tea, black tea and tea leaves, and make the tea.*

166.1 开水 (kāishuǐ) — boiled water; boiling water

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a skirt, then the Mandarin for a scarf.

You'll want to know: 开水

开水 — *kāishuǐ* — "boiled water; boiling water".

> 中午我们吃米饭喝开水 *zhōngwǔ wǒmen chī mǐfàn hē kāishuǐ* — At midday we have rice and drink boiled water.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开水 (*kāishuǐ*) is built from 开 'to open', here 'to come to the boil', and 水 'water', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *sywijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the boiling sense is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāishuǐ*
- *Say it: kāishuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhōngwǔ wǒmen chī mǐfàn hē kāishuǐ* — At midday we have rice and drink boiled water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a skirt, then the Mandarin for a scarf, then say *kāishuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 开水 mean? ("Boiled water; boiling water".) Say it once more.

166.2 下午茶 (xiàwǔchá) — afternoon tea (a light meal)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a scarf, then the Mandarin for boiled water.

You'll want to know: 下午茶

下午茶 — *xiàwǔchá* — "afternoon tea (a light meal)".

我们三点吃下午茶 *wǒmen sān diǎn chī xiàwǔchá* — We have afternoon tea at three.

The new character, in pieces: 茶 — nine strokes in three pieces: the grass piece of 菜 on top, the two strokes of 人 under it, and at the foot a horizontal, a vertical with a hook, and two short strokes on either side of it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

下午茶 (*xiàwǔchá*) is built from 下午 'afternoon' and 茶 'tea'. All three parts are inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX*, *nguX* and *drae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary marks the tea character as a popular form. Tea with something to eat, as a light meal of its own.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàwǔchá*
- *Say it: xiàwǔchá*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen sān diǎn chī xiàwǔchá* — We have afternoon tea at three.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a scarf, then the Mandarin for boiled water, then say *xiàwǔchá* again

Before you move on

What does 下午茶 mean? ("Afternoon tea (a light meal)".) Say it once more.

166.3 茶 — grass, a roof, a small tree

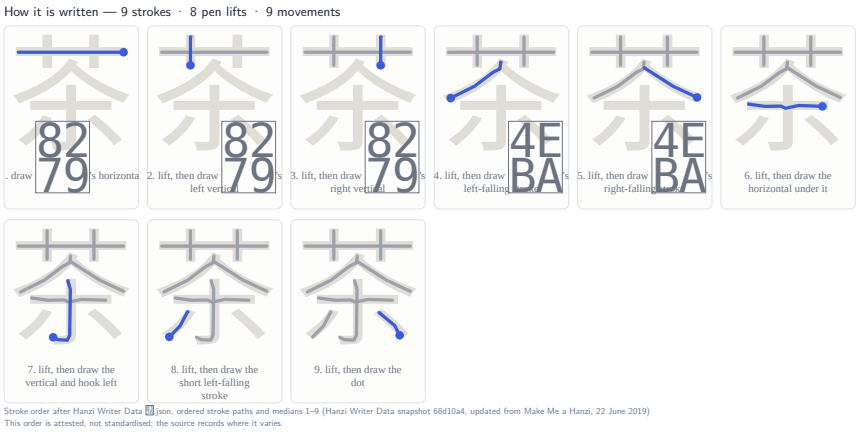
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiàwǔchá* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  菜 人

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *cài*, *rén*

Script — grass, a roof, a small tree



How 茶 is written, stroke by stroke

茶

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The grass piece, three strokes, as in 菜: a horizontal, then two short verticals through it.

Then 人, two strokes, spread wide like a roof.

At the foot, four strokes: a horizontal, a vertical with a hook, then a short stroke falling to the left and a dot falling to the right, one on each side.

3 + 2 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 茶, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 茶? (**Nine.**) What sits on top? (**The grass piece of 菜.**) What comes under it? (**人, spread like a roof.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 茶, pinned stroke paths and medians.

166.4 hóngchá — black tea

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for boiled water, then the Mandarin for afternoon tea.

You'll want to know: hóngchá

hóngchá — "black tea".

nǐ yào hóngchá háishi lǜchá — Black tea or green tea?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
English calls this tea black; Mandarin calls it red.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hóngchá is built from *hóng* 'red' and 茶 'tea', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwng* and *drae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: hóngchá*
- *Say it: hóngchá*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yào hóngchá háishi lǜchá* — Black tea or green tea?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for boiled water, then the Mandarin for afternoon tea, then say *hóngchá* again

Before you move on

What does hóngchá mean? ("Black tea".) Say it once more.

166.5 cháyè — tea leaves

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for afternoon tea, then the Mandarin for black tea.

You'll want to know: cháyè

cháyè — "tea leaves".

> *cháyè zài nǎr* — Where are the tea leaves?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cháyè is built from 茶 'tea' and *yè* 'leaf', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drae* and *yep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the leaves of a branch'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: cháyè*
- *Say it: cháyè*, once more
- *Say it: cháyè zài nǎr* — Where are the tea leaves?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for afternoon tea, then the Mandarin for black tea, then say *cháyè* again

Before you move on

What does cháyè mean? ("Tea leaves".) Say it once more.

166.6 pàochá — to make tea (to steep the leaves)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for black tea, then the Mandarin for tea leaves.

You'll want to know: pàochá

pàochá — "to make tea (to steep the leaves)".

> *wǒ yòng kāishuǐ pàochá* — I make the tea with boiling water.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pàochá is built from *pào* 'to soak' and 茶 'tea', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phaew* and *drae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'bubbles on water'; soaking is not given there, and *phaew* would regularly give a first tone, so how *pào* came about is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: pàochá*
- *Say it: pàochá*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yòng kāishuǐ pàochá* — I make the tea with boiling water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for black tea, then the Mandarin for tea leaves, then say *pàochá* again

Before you move on

What does pàochá mean? ("To make tea (to steep the leaves)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 167

The Day Before Yesterday

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what happened the day before yesterday: a power cut, a noise, and that it was nothing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can say what happened the day before yesterday: a power cut, a noise, and that it was nothing.*

167.1 前天 (qiántiān) — the day before yesterday

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tea leaves, then the Mandarin for to make tea.

You'll want to know: 前天

前天 — *qiántiān* — "the day before yesterday".

> 前天是星期一 *qiántiān shì xīngqīyī* — The day before yesterday was Monday.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

前天 (*qiántiān*) is built from 前 'before' and 天 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzen* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiántiān*
- *Say it: qiántiān*, once more
- *Say it: qiántiān shì xīngqīyī* — The day before yesterday was Monday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tea leaves, then the Mandarin for to make tea, then say *qiántiān* again

Before you move on

What does 前天 mean? ("The day before yesterday".) Say it once more.

167.2 fāshēng — to happen; to take place

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make tea, then the Mandarin for the day before yesterday.

You'll want to know: fāshēng

fāshēng — "to happen; to take place".

qiántiān wǎnshang fāshēng le shénme — What happened the night before last?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāshēng is built from two parts inherited from Middle Chinese (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): *pjot*, glossed 'to rise' and 'to start', the word in *chūfā*, and *srjaeng*, 生 'to be born': to start up and come into being.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāshēng*
- *Say it: fāshēng*, once more
- *Say it: qiántiān wǎnshang fāshēng le shénme* — What happened the night before last?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make tea, then the Mandarin for the day before yesterday, then say *fāshēng* again

Before you move on

What does fāshēng mean? ("To happen; to take place".) Say it once more.

167.3 没事 (méishì) — it's nothing; to be all right

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the day before yesterday, then the Mandarin for to happen.

You'll want to know: 没事

没事 — *méishì* — "it's nothing; to be all right".

没事我很好 *méishì wǒ hěn hǎo* — It's nothing. I'm fine.

The new character, in pieces: 事 — eight strokes: a horizontal, a small 口, a horizontal that turns down, a long horizontal, a shorter one, and last a vertical with a hook down through them all. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

没事 (*méishì*) is built from 没 'not to have' and 事 'matter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mwot* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to sink' and the second 'to employ' and 'to set up'; 'a matter' is the everyday sense, not the gloss. *Mwot* would regularly give mò, not méi.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: méishì*
- *Say it: méishì*, once more
- *Say it: méishì wǒ hěn hǎo* — It's nothing. I'm fine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the day before yesterday, then the Mandarin for to happen, then say *méishì* again

Before you move on

What does 没事 mean? ("It's nothing; to be all right".) Say it once more.

167.4 事 — a bar, 口, three bars and a long hook

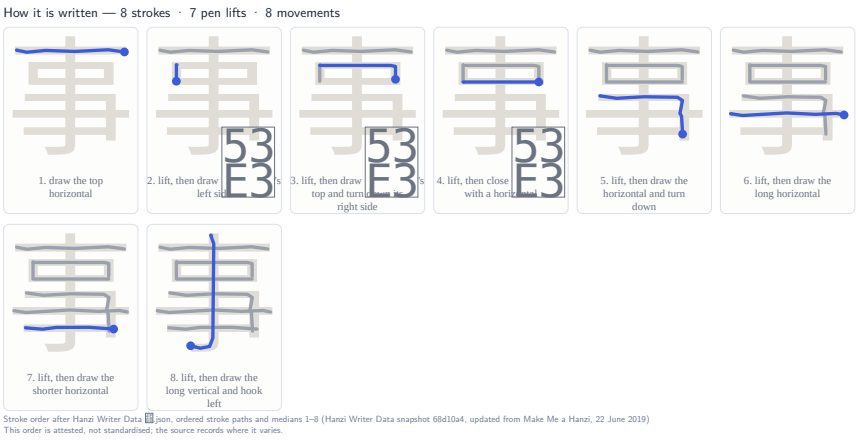
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *méishì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

口 有

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *yǒu*

Script — a bar, 口, three bars and a long hook



How 事 *is written, stroke by stroke*

事

One shape, eight strokes, threaded on a long hook.
A horizontal across the top.
Then a small 口, three strokes, as you write it.
Then three bars: a horizontal that turns down at its right end, a long horizontal across, and a shorter one under it.
Last, a vertical with a hook, from the top bar down through everything: the longest stroke.
$1 + 3 + 3 + 1 =$ eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 事, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 事? (**Eight.**) Which piece is second? (**A small 口.**) Which stroke comes last? (**The long vertical with the hook.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 事, pinned stroke paths and medians.

167.5 tíngdiàn — to have a power cut

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to happen, then the Mandarin for it's nothing.

You'll want to know: tíngdiàn

tíngdiàn — "to have a power cut".

qiántiān wǎnshang tíngdiàn le — There was a power cut the night before last.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tíngdiàn is built from *tíng* 'to stop' and 电 'lightning, electricity', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *deng* and *denH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíngdiàn*
- *Say it: tíngdiàn*, once more
- *Say it: qiántiān wǎnshang tíngdiàn le* — There was a power cut the night before last.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to happen, then the Mandarin for it's nothing, then say *tíngdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does tíngdiàn mean? ("To have a power cut".) Say it once more.

167.6 shēngyīn — sound; voice; noise

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for it's nothing, then the Mandarin for to have a power cut.

You'll want to know: shēngyīn

shēngyīn — "sound; voice; noise".

wàibian yǒu shénme shēngyīn — What's that noise outside?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēngyīn is built from *shēng* and 音, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syeng* and *'im* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with this very word and the second as sound made with measure.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngyīn*
- *Say it: shēngyīn*, once more
- *Say it: wàibian yǒu shénme shēngyīn* — What's that noise outside?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for it's nothing, then the Mandarin for to have a power cut, then say *shēngyīn* again

Before you move on

What does shēngyīn mean? ("Sound; voice; noise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 168

Steamed or Fried

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about steaming, deep-frying, stewing and boiling water, and ask for sugar.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can talk about steaming, deep-frying, stewing and boiling water, and ask for sugar.*

168.1 zhēng — to steam (food)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a power cut, then the Mandarin for a sound.

You'll want to know: zhēng

zhēng — "to steam (food)".

> *māma zài zhēng bāozi* — Mum is steaming buns.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhēng is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsying* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Under this character the dictionary gives 'fine firewood'; written another way, the same syllable is glossed 'the breath of a fire rising', which is the steaming.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhēng*
- *Say it: zhēng*, once more
- *Say it: māma zài zhēng bāozi* — Mum is steaming buns.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a power cut, then the Mandarin for a sound, then say *zhēng* again

Before you move on

What does zhēng mean? ("To steam (food)".) Say it once more.

168.2 zhá — to deep-fry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sound, then the Mandarin for to steam.

You'll want to know: zhá

zhá — "to deep-fry".

jīntiān wǎnshang wǒmen zhá yú — We're deep-frying fish tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhá is probably the word the Guangyun writes another way as *dzreap*, glossed 'to scald in hot water' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which would regularly give zhá; but no dictionary we use joins that word to this character, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhá*
- *Say it: zhá*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǎnshang wǒmen zhá yú* — We're deep-frying fish tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sound, then the Mandarin for to steam, then say *zhá* again

Before you move on

What does zhá mean? ("To deep-fry".) Say it once more.

168.3 dùn — to stew

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to steam, then the Mandarin for to deep-fry.

You'll want to know: dùn

dùn — "to stew".

tā zài dùn ròu — He's stewing some meat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dùn has no older form of this word in any dictionary we use. The Guangyun lists the character as *dwon*, glossed 'a blazing fire' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), but neither that sense nor that sound gives today's word, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dùn*
- *Say it: dùn*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài dùn ròu* — He's stewing some meat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to steam, then the Mandarin for to deep-fry, then say *dùn* again

Before you move on

What does dùn mean? ("To stew".) Say it once more.

168.4 shāoshuǐ — to boil water

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to deep-fry, then the Mandarin for to stew.

You'll want to know: shāoshuǐ

shāoshuǐ — "to boil water".

wǒ qù shāoshuǐ nǐmen yào hē chá ma — I'll put the kettle on: who wants tea?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāoshuǐ is built from *shāo* 'to burn' and 水 'water', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syew* and *sywijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'fire' and 'to set alight'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāoshuǐ*
- *Say it: shāoshuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù shāoshuǐ nǐmen yào hē chá ma* — I'll put the kettle on: who wants tea?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to deep-fry, then the Mandarin for to stew, then say *shāoshuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does shāoshuǐ mean? ("To boil water".) Say it once more.

168.5 táng — sugar; sweets

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stew, then the Mandarin for to boil water.

You'll want to know: táng

táng — "sugar; sweets".

zhège tāng yào fàng yìdiǎnr táng — This soup needs a little sugar in it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

táng is inherited from Middle Chinese *dang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'malt syrup'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: táng*
- *Say it: táng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège tāng yào fàng yìdiǎnr táng* — This soup needs a little sugar in it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stew, then the Mandarin for to boil water, then say *táng* again

Before you move on

What does táng mean? ("Sugar; sweets".) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

Early and Late

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about first thing in the morning, an afternoon nap, dusk, staying up and the dead of night.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can talk about first thing in the morning, an afternoon nap, dusk, staying up and the dead of night.*

169.1 一大早 (yídàzǎo) — first thing in the morning; at the crack of dawn

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to boil water, then the Mandarin for sugar.

You'll want to know: 一大早

一大早 — *yídàzǎo* — "first thing in the morning; at the crack of dawn".

> 一大早妈妈去买大米了 *yídàzǎo māma qù mǎi dàmǐ le* — First thing this morning my mum went out to buy rice.

The tone of 一 changes: yī is said yí before the fourth tone of dà.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一大早 (*yídàzǎo*) is built from 一 'one', 大 'big' and 早 'early', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit*, *daH* and *tsawX* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'morning'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: yídàzǎo*
- *Say it: yídàzǎo*, once more
- *Say it: yídàzǎo māma qù mǎi dàmǐ le* — First thing this morning my mum went out to buy rice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to boil water, then the Mandarin for sugar, then say *yídàzǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 一大早 mean? ("First thing in the morning; at the crack of dawn".) Say it once more.

169.2 午觉 (wǔjiào) — afternoon nap

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sugar, then the Mandarin for first thing in the morning.

You'll want to know: 午觉

午觉 — *wǔjiào* — "afternoon nap".

午觉以后我们喝茶 *wǔjiào yǐhòu wǒmen hē chá* — After the nap we'll have tea.

The new character, in pieces: 觉 — nine strokes: three short strokes on top, the cover piece of 学 under them, and 见 at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

午觉 (*wǔjiào*) is built from 午 'noon' and 觉 'sleep', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nguX* and *kaewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second with the word for sleeping. The same character read *jué*, as in 觉得, is its other reading, glossed 'to wake' and 'to know'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǔjiào*
- *Say it: wǔjiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǔjiào yǐhòu wǒmen hē chá* — After the nap we'll have tea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sugar, then the Mandarin for first thing in the morning, then say *wǔjiào* again

Before you move on

What does 午觉 mean? ("Afternoon nap".) Say it once more.

169.3 觉 — three strokes, a cover, then 见

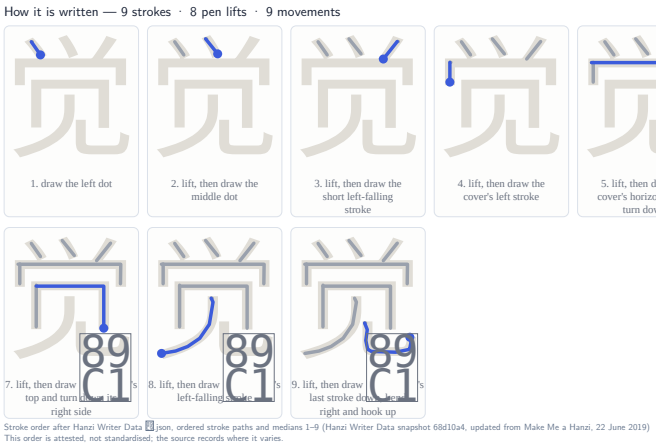
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wǔjiào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  见 学

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jiàn*, *xué*

Script — three strokes, a cover, then 见



How 觉 is written, stroke by stroke

觉

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

Three short strokes on top: a dot on the left, a dot in the middle, and a short stroke on the right falling to the left.

Then the cover piece of 学, two strokes: a short stroke falling down on the left, then a horizontal that turns down and hooks.

Then 见, four strokes, as you write it, under the cover.

3 + 2 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 觉, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 觉? (**Nine**.) What sits under the cover? (见.) Which word holds the cover too? (学.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 觉, pinned stroke paths and medians.

169.4 bàngwǎn — dusk; towards evening

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for first thing in the morning, then the Mandarin for an afternoon nap.

You'll want to know: bàngwǎn

bàngwǎn — "dusk; towards evening".

wǒmen bàngwǎn qù sànbù — We go for a walk around dusk.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàngwǎn is built from *bàng* 'near' and 晚 'evening', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bangH* and *mjonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary gives the sense 'near' under the level-tone reading of the first; today's falling tone goes with *bangH*, which it leaves without a gloss.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàngwǎn*
- *Say it: bàngwǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen bàngwǎn qù sànbù* — We go for a walk around dusk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for first thing in the morning, then the Mandarin for an afternoon nap, then say *bàngwǎn* again

Before you move on

What does bàngwǎn mean? ("Dusk; towards evening".) Say it once more.

169.5 áoyè — to stay up late; to stay up all night

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an afternoon nap, then the Mandarin for towards evening.

You'll want to know: áoyè

áoyè — "to stay up late; to stay up all night".

wǒ zuótiān áoyè le jīntiān hěn lèi — I stayed up late last night, and I'm tired today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

áoyè is built from *áo* 'to simmer' and *yè* 'night', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngaw* and *yaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to simmer'. How the pair came to mean staying up is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: áoyè*
- *Say it: áoyè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuótiān áoyè le jīntiān hěn lèi* — I stayed up late last night, and I'm tired today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an afternoon nap, then the Mandarin for towards evening, then say *áoyè* again

Before you move on

What does áoyè mean? ("To stay up late; to stay up all night".) Say it once more.

169.6 shēnyè — late at night; the dead of night

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for towards evening, then the Mandarin for to stay up late.

You'll want to know: shēnyè

shēnyè — "late at night; the dead of night".

shēnyè wàibian hěn ānjìng — Late at night it's quiet outside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēnyè is built from *shēn* 'deep' and *yè* 'night', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syim* and *yaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): deep in the night. The dictionary gives 'deep' under the falling-tone reading *syimH*; today's level tone goes with *syim*.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnyè*
- *Say it: shēnyè*, once more
- *Say it: shēnyè wàibian hěn ānjìng* — Late at night it's quiet outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for towards evening, then the Mandarin for to stay up late, then say *shēnyè* again

Before you move on

What does shēnyè mean? ("Late at night; the dead of night".) Say it once more.

169.7 Looking back: from Getting Ready to Early and Late

Say the Mandarin for to dress up and to wash one's hair.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to dress up, to wash one's hair, a hair dryer, to put on make-up, to have a shave
- *Say it:* an overcoat, a sweater, measure word for long things, a skirt, a scarf
- *Say it:* boiled water, afternoon tea, black tea, tea leaves, to make tea
- *Say it:* the day before yesterday, to happen, it's nothing, to have a power cut, a sound
- *Say it:* to steam, to deep-fry, to stew, to boil water, sugar
- *Say it:* first thing in the morning, an afternoon nap, towards evening, to stay up late, late at night
- *Read it:* 衣 茶 事 觉 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To dress up? (*dǎban.*) To wash one's hair? (*xǐtóu.*) A hair dryer? (*chuīfēngjī.*) To put on make-up? (*huàzhuāng.*) To have a shave? (*guāliǎn.*) An overcoat? (大衣, *dàyī.*) A sweater? (*máoyī.*) Measure word for long things? (*tiáo.*) A skirt? (*qúnzi.*) A scarf? (*wéijīn.*) Boiled water? (开水, *kāishuǐ.*) Afternoon tea? (下午茶, *xiàwǔchá.*) Black tea? (*hóngchá.*) Tea leaves? (*cháyè.*) To make tea? (*pàochá.*) The day before yesterday? (前天, *qiántiān.*) To happen? (*fāshēng.*) It's nothing? (没事, *méishì.*) To have a power cut? (*tíngdiàn.*) A sound? (*shēngyīn.*) To steam? (*zhēng.*) To deep-fry? (*zhá.*) To stew? (*dùn.*) To boil water? (*shāoshuǐ.*) Sugar? (*táng.*) First thing in the morning? (一大早, *yídàzǎo.*) An afternoon nap? (午觉, *wǔjiào.*) Towards evening? (*bàngwǎn.*) To stay up late? (*áoyè.*) Late at night? (*shēnyè.*)

Chapter 170

Pots and Pans

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a wok, a teacup, a spoon, a fork and a microwave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can name a wok, a teacup, a spoon, a fork and a microwave.*

170.1 guō — pot; pan; wok

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stay up late, then the Mandarin for late at night.

You'll want to know: guō

guō — "pot; pan; wok".

> *zhège guō hěn zhòng* — This wok is heavy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guō is inherited from Middle Chinese *kwa* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a vessel for warming'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: guō*
- *Say it: guō*, once more
- *Say it: zhège guō hěn zhòng* — This wok is heavy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stay up late, then the Mandarin for late at night, then say *guō* again

Before you move on

What does guō mean? ("Pot; pan; wok".) Say it once more.

170.2 茶杯 (chábēi) — teacup

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for late at night, then the Mandarin for a cooking pot.

You'll want to know: 茶杯

茶杯 — *chábēi* — "teacup".

我觉得这个茶杯很好看 *wǒ juéde zhège chábēi hěn hǎokàn* — I think this teacup is lovely.

The new character, in pieces: 杯 — eight strokes in two pieces: the tree piece on the left of 机, four strokes, and 不 on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

茶杯 (*chábēi*) is built from 茶 'tea' and 杯 'cup', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drae* and *pwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chábēi*
- *Say it: chábēi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège chábēi hěn hǎokàn* — I think this teacup is lovely.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for late at night, then the Mandarin for a cooking pot, then say *chábēi* again

Before you move on

What does 茶杯 mean? (“Teacup”.) Say it once more.

170.3 杯 — a tree piece, then 不

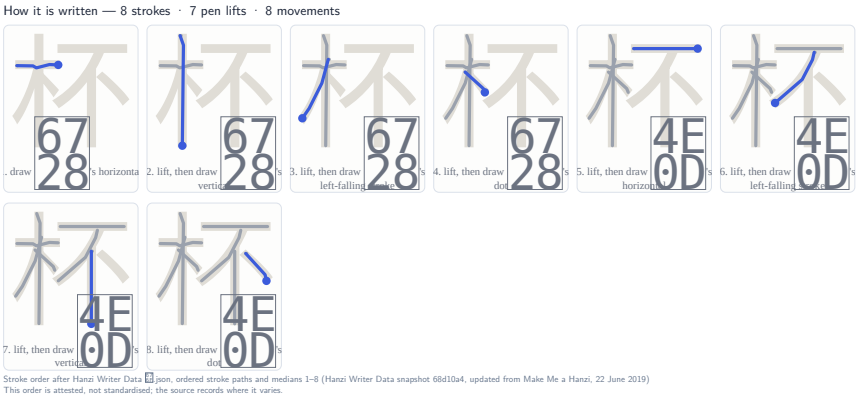
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chábēi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  不 机

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bù*, *jī*

Script — a tree piece, then 不



How 杯 is written, stroke by stroke

杯

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, four strokes: the tree piece, as on the left of 机. A horizontal. A vertical down through it. A stroke falling to the lower left from the crossing. Then a dot to the lower right, where 本 has a long stroke.

The right piece, 不, four strokes, as you write it: a horizontal, a stroke falling to the left, a vertical, and a dot.

4 + 4 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 杯, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 杯? (**Eight**.) What is the right-hand piece? (不.) How does the tree piece end? (**With a dot, not a long stroke**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 杯, pinned stroke paths and medians.

170.4 sháozi — spoon; ladle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a cooking pot, then the Mandarin for a teacup.

You'll want to know: sháozi

sháozi — "spoon; ladle".

wǒ yào yí ge sháozi — Could I have a spoon?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sháozi is built from *sháo* 'ladle' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyak* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first as a drinking vessel. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: sháozi*
- *Say it: sháozi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào yí ge sháozi* — Could I have a spoon?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a cooking pot, then the Mandarin for a teacup, then say *sháozi* again

Before you move on

What does sháozi mean? ("Spoon; ladle".) Say it once more.

170.5 chāzi — fork

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a teacup, then the Mandarin for a spoon.

You'll want to know: chāzi

chāzi — "fork".

nǐ yòng kuàizi háishi yòng chāzi — Chopsticks or a fork?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chāzi is built from *chā* and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhae* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'hands crossed', and under a second reading 'two branches': a forked thing. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāzi*
- *Say it: chāzi*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yòng kuàizi háishi yòng chāzi* — Chopsticks or a fork?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a teacup, then the Mandarin for a spoon, then say *chāzi* again

Before you move on

What does chāzi mean? ("Fork".) Say it once more.

170.6 wēibōlú — microwave oven

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a spoon, then the Mandarin for a fork.

You'll want to know: wēibōlú

wēibōlú — "microwave oven".

fàn zài wēibōlú lǐ — The food is in the microwave.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wēibōlú is built from *wēi* 'tiny', *bō* 'wave' and *lú* 'stove', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *mj+j*, *pa* and *lu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): old words put together to name a new machine.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: wēibōlú*
- *Say it: wēibōlú*, once more
- *Say it: fàn zài wēibōlú lǐ* — The food is in the microwave.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a spoon, then the Mandarin for a fork, then say *wēibōlú* again

Before you move on

What does wēibōlú mean? (“Microwave oven”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 171

Switching Things On

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can open things, put the air conditioning on, use the remote, press buttons and say what not to touch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can open things, put the air conditioning on, use the remote, press buttons and say what not to touch.*

171.1 打开 (dǎkāi) — to open; to switch on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a fork, then the Mandarin for a microwave oven.

You'll want to know: 打开

打开 — *dǎkāi* — "to open; to switch on".

> 你去打开书房的门 *nǐ qù dǎkāi shūfáng de mén* — Go and open the study door.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

打开 (*dǎkāi*) is built from 打 'to strike' and 开 'to open', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *khoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), though dǎ is not the sound *taengX* would regularly give.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎkāi*
- *Say it: dǎkāi*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ qù dǎkāi shūfáng de mén* — Go and open the study door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a fork, then the Mandarin for a microwave oven, then say *dǎkāi* again

Before you move on

What does 打开 mean? ("To open; to switch on".) Say it once more.

171.2 kōngtiáo — air conditioner; air conditioning

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a microwave oven, then the Mandarin for to switch on.

You'll want to know: kōngtiáo

kōngtiáo — "air conditioner; air conditioning".

jīntiān tài rè le wǒmen kāi kōngtiáo — It's far too hot today: let's put the air conditioner on.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kōngtiáo is built from *kōng* 'empty', here the air, and *tiáo* 'to adjust': a short name for the machine that adjusts the air. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *khuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'empty'; the second is listed there as *dew*, glossed 'to harmonize'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōngtiáo*
- *Say it: kōngtiáo*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān tài rè le wǒmen kāi kōngtiáo* — It's far too hot today: let's put the air conditioner on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a microwave oven, then the Mandarin for to switch on, then say *kōngtiáo* again

Before you move on

What does kōngtiáo mean? ("Air conditioner; air conditioning".) Say it once more.

171.3 yáokòngqì — remote control

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to switch on, then the Mandarin for an air conditioner.

You'll want to know: yáokòngqì

yáokòngqì — "remote control".

yáokòngqì zài nǎr — Where's the remote?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yáokòngqì is built from *yáo* 'far', *kòng* 'to control' and *qì* 'device'. The last is inherited from Middle Chinese *khijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a vessel'; the first two are listed there as *yew*, glossed 'far', and *khuwngH*, glossed 'to pull': a device that pulls from far away.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: yáokòngqì*
- *Say it: yáokòngqì*, once more
- *Say it: yáokòngqì zài nǎr* — Where's the remote?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to switch on, then the Mandarin for an air conditioner, then say *yáokòngqì* again

Before you move on

What does yáokòngqì mean? ("Remote control".) Say it once more.

171.4 àn — to press; to push down

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an air conditioner, then the Mandarin for a remote control.

You'll want to know: àn

àn — "to press; to push down".

qǐng àn zhège — Please press this one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

àn is inherited from Middle Chinese *'anH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to press down' and 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: àn*
- *Say it: àn*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng àn zhège* — Please press this one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an air conditioner, then the Mandarin for a remote control, then say *àn* again

Before you move on

What does àn mean? ("To press; to push down".) Say it once more.

171.5 pèng — to touch; to bump into

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a remote control, then the Mandarin for to press a button.

You'll want to know: pèng

pèng — "to touch; to bump into".

bié pèng zhège hěn rè — Don't touch that: it's hot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pèng No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: pèng*
- *Say it: pèng*, once more
- *Say it: bié pèng zhège hěn rè* — Don't touch that: it's hot.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a remote control, then the Mandarin for to press a button, then say *pèng* again

Before you move on

What does pèng mean? (“To touch; to bump into”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

Sweet and Sour

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how food tastes: good, sour, bitter, fragrant or bland.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say how food tastes: good, sour, bitter, fragrant or bland.*

172.1 wèidao — taste; flavour

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to press a button, then the Mandarin for to touch.

You'll want to know: wèidao

wèidao — "taste; flavour".

> *zhège cài de wèidao hěn hǎo* — This dish tastes good.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wèidao is built from *wèi* 'taste' and *dao*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mj+jH* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the five tastes, sour, salty, sweet, bitter and hot, and the second 'a road'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: wèidao*
- *Say it: wèidao*, once more
- *Say it: zhège cài de wèidao hěn hǎo* — This dish tastes good.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to press a button, then the Mandarin for to touch, then say *wèidao* again

Before you move on

What does wèidao mean? ("Taste; flavour".) Say it once more.

172.2 suān — sour

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to touch, then the Mandarin for a flavour.

You'll want to know: suān

suān — "sour".

zhège píngguǒ hěn suān — This apple is sour.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suān is inherited from Middle Chinese *swan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'vinegar': the taste of vinegar.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: suān*
- *Say it: suān*, once more
- *Say it: zhège píngguǒ hěn suān* — This apple is sour.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to touch, then the Mandarin for a flavour, then say *suān* again

Before you move on

What does suān mean? (“Sour”.) Say it once more.

172.3 kǔ — bitter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a flavour, then the Mandarin for sour.

You’ll want to know: kǔ

kǔ — “bitter”.

zhège kāfēi tài kǔ le — This coffee is too bitter.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kǔ is inherited from Middle Chinese *khuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’coarse’, ’toil’ and ’suffering’; the taste itself is not given there in so many words.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǔ*
- *Say it: kǔ*, once more

- *Say it: zhège kāfēi tài kǔ le* — This coffee is too bitter.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a flavour, then the Mandarin for sour, then say *kǔ* again

Before you move on

What does kǔ mean? (“Bitter”.) Say it once more.

172.4 xiāng — smelling good; fragrant; tasty

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sour, then the Mandarin for bitter.

You’ll want to know: xiāng

xiāng — “smelling good; fragrant; tasty”.

nǐ zuò de fàn zhēn xiāng — The food you cook smells wonderful.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāng is inherited from Middle Chinese *xjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’fragrant’.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāng*
- *Say it: xiāng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuò de fàn zhēn xiāng* — The food you cook smells wonderful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sour, then the Mandarin for bitter, then say *xiāng* again

Before you move on

What does xiāng mean? ("Smelling good; fragrant; tasty".) Say it once more.

172.5 dàn — bland; weak (in taste)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bitter, then the Mandarin for smelling good.

You'll want to know: dàn

dàn — "bland; weak (in taste)".

tāng tài dàn le — The soup is too bland.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *damX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a thin taste'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàn*
- *Say it: dàn*, once more
- *Say it: tāng tài dàn le* — The soup is too bland.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bitter, then the Mandarin for smelling good, then say *dàn* again

Before you move on

What does dàn mean? ("Bland; weak (in taste)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 173

An Invitation

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can invite people, send my regards, and talk about an evening party, a get-together and who pays.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can invite people, send my regards, and talk about an evening party, a get-together and who pays.*

173.1 yāoqǐng — to invite; an invitation

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for smelling good, then the Mandarin for bland.

You'll want to know: yāoqǐng

yāoqǐng — "to invite; an invitation".

> *tā yāoqǐng wǒmen qù tā jiā* — He's invited us to his place.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yāoqǐng is built from *yāo* and 请 'to ask', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jiew* and *tshjengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to stop someone on the way'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yāoqǐng*
- *Say it: yāoqǐng*, once more
- *Say it: tā yāoqǐng wǒmen qù tā jiā* — He's invited us to his place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for smelling good, then the Mandarin for bland, then say *yāoqǐng* again

Before you move on

What does yāoqǐng mean? ("To invite; an invitation".) Say it once more.

173.2 问候 (wènhòu) — to send regards to; to greet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bland, then the Mandarin for to invite.

You'll want to know: 问候

问候 — *wènhòu* — "to send regards to; to greet".

nǐ bāng wǒ wènhòu nǐ bàba māma — Give my regards to your mum and dad.

The new character, in pieces: 候 — ten strokes: the person piece, a thin vertical beside it, then on the right a small hooked top, a horizontal, and a base of five strokes: a short stroke falling to the left, two horizontals, and two long strokes falling to either side. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

问候 (*wènhòu*) is built from 问 'to ask' and 候 'to wait upon', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjunH* and *huwH* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription): to ask after someone. The second is a different word from 后 'after', *huwX*.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: wènhòu*
- *Say it: wènhòu*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bāng wǒ wènhòu nǐ bàba māma* — Give my regards to your mum and dad.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bland, then the Mandarin for to invite, then say *wènhòu* again

Before you move on

What does 问候 mean? ("To send regards to; to greet".) Say it once more.

173.3 候 — the person piece, a thin stroke, then the right side

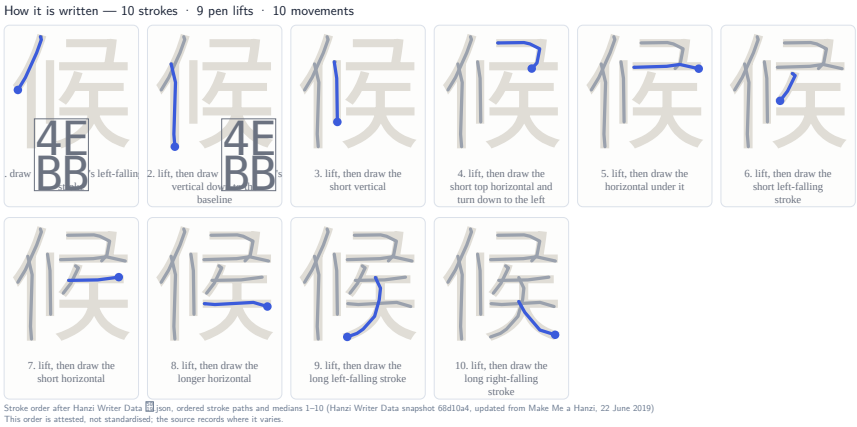
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wènhòu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  亻 问

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — the person piece, *wèn*

Script — the person piece, a thin stroke, then the right side



How 候 *is written, stroke by stroke*

候

Three pieces, left to right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.
The person piece, 亻 **, two strokes,** as in 你.
A thin vertical, one short stroke standing beside it.
The right side, seven strokes. On top a short horizontal that turns and falls to the left, like a small hook. A horizontal under it. Then the base, five strokes: a short stroke falling to the left, a short horizontal, a longer horizontal, a long stroke falling to the left through them, and a long stroke falling to the right.
2 + 1 + 7 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 候, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 候? (**Ten.**) What comes after the person piece? (**One thin vertical.**) How many strokes in the base? (**Five.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 候, pinned stroke paths and medians.

173.4 晚会 (wǎnhuì) — evening party; evening show

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to invite, then the Mandarin for to send regards to.

You'll want to know: 晚会

晚会 — *wǎnhuì* — "evening party; evening show".

晚上我有事不能去晚会 *wǎnshang wǒ yǒushì bù néng qù wǎnhuì* — I've got something on tonight, so I can't come to the party.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

晚会 (*wǎnhuì*) is built from **晚** 'evening' and **会** 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonX* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to come together'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎnhuì*
- *Say it: wǎnhuì*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang wǒ yǒushì bù néng qù wǎnhuì* — I've got something on tonight, so I can't come to the party.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to invite, then the Mandarin for to send regards to, then say *wǎnhuì* again

Before you move on

What does **晚会** mean? ("Evening party; evening show".) Say it once more.

173.5 jùhuì — get-together; party

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to send regards to, then the Mandarin for an evening party.

You'll want to know: jùhuì

jùhuì — "get-together; party".

zhōumò wǒmen yǒu yí ge jùhuì nǐ lái ma — We're having a get-together at the weekend: are you coming?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jùhuì is built from *jù* 'to gather' and 会 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjuX* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'many' and 'to gather', and quotes an older book that glosses it with the second.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: jùhuì*
- *Say it: jùhuì*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen yǒu yí ge jùhuì nǐ lái ma* — We're having a get-together at the weekend: are you coming?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to send regards to, then the Mandarin for an evening party, then say *jùhuì* again

Before you move on

What does jùhuì mean? ("Get-together; party".) Say it once more.

173.6 请客 (qǐngkè) — to pay for everyone; to treat (the others)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an evening party, then the Mandarin for a get-together.

You'll want to know: 请客

请客 — *qǐngkè* — "to pay for everyone; to treat (the others)".

> 今天我请客每个人一杯茶 *jīntiān wǒ qǐngkè měi ge rén yì bēi chá* — It's on me today: a cup of tea each.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

请客 (*qǐngkè*) is built from 请 'to ask, to invite' and 客 'guest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjengX* and *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to have the others as your guests, and so to pay.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐngkè*
- *Say it: qǐngkè*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒ qǐngkè měi ge rén yì bēi chá* — It's on me today: a cup of tea each.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an evening party, then the Mandarin for a get-together, then say *qǐngkè* again

Before you move on

What does 请客 mean? ("To pay for everyone; to treat (the others)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 174

Jobs Around the House

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can hang things up, sort things out, lift them together, and talk about a ladder and a light bulb.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can hang things up, sort things out, lift them together, and talk about a ladder and a light bulb.*

174.1 guà — to hang; to hang up

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a get-together, then the Mandarin for to pay for everyone.

You'll want to know: guà

guà — "to hang; to hang up".

> *mén hòubian kěyǐ guà dàyī* — You can hang your coat behind the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guà is inherited from Middle Chinese *kweaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to hang', under a popular way of writing it.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: guà*
- *Say it: guà*, once more
- *Say it: mén hòubian kěyǐ guà dàyī* — You can hang your coat behind the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a get-together, then the Mandarin for to pay for everyone, then say *guà* again

Before you move on

What does guà mean? ("To hang; to hang up".) Say it once more.

174.2 nòng — to sort something out; to do; to handle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay for everyone, then the Mandarin for to hang something up.

You'll want to know: nòng

nòng — "to sort something out; to do; to handle".

diànnǎo huài le nǐ huì nòng ma — The computer's broken: do you know how to sort it out?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nòng is inherited from Middle Chinese *luwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to play with'. Its first sound would regularly give lòng; how it came to be said with n is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nòng*
- *Say it: nòng*, once more
- *Say it: diànnǎo huài le nǐ huì nòng ma* — The computer's broken: do you know how to sort it out?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay for everyone, then the Mandarin for to hang something up, then say *nòng* again

Before you move on

What does nòng mean? ("To sort something out; to do; to handle".) Say it once more.

174.3 tái — to lift; to carry (between two people)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hang something up, then the Mandarin for to sort something out.

You'll want to know: tái

tái — "to lift; to carry (between two people)".

zhège zhuōzi hěn zhòng wǒmen yìqǐ tái — This table is heavy: let's lift it together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tái is inherited from Middle Chinese *doj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), written there another way and glossed 'to lift up'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tái*
- *Say it: tái*, once more
- *Say it: zhège zhuōzi hěn zhòng wǒmen yìqǐ tái* — This table is heavy: let's lift it together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hang something up, then the Mandarin for to sort something out, then say *tái* again

Before you move on

What does tái mean? ("To lift; to carry (between two people)".) Say it once more.

174.4 tīzi — ladder

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sort something out, then the Mandarin for to lift together.

You'll want to know: tīzi

tīzi — "ladder".

wǒmen yìqǐ tái tīzi — Let's carry the ladder together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tīzi is built from *tī* and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thej* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'wooden steps'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīzi*
- *Say it: tīzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yìqǐ tái tīzi* — Let's carry the ladder together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sort something out, then the Mandarin for to lift together, then say *tīzi* again

Before you move on

What does tīzi mean? ("Ladder".) Say it once more.

174.5 dēngpào — light bulb

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lift together, then the Mandarin for a ladder.

You'll want to know: dēngpào

dēngpào — "light bulb".

dēngpào huài le wǒmen yào huàn yí ge — The bulb's gone, so we need to change it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēngpào is built from *dēng* 'lamp' and *pào* 'bubble', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong* and *phaew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'bubbles on water': the lamp's glass bubble. *Phaew* would regularly give a first tone, so how *pào* came about is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēngpào*
- *Say it: dēngpào*, once more
- *Say it: dēngpào huài le wǒmen yào huàn yí ge* — The bulb's gone, so we need to change it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lift together, then the Mandarin for a ladder, then say *dēngpào* again

Before you move on

What does dēngpào mean? ("Light bulb".) Say it once more.

Chapter 175

Sofa and Shelves

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name furniture, a sofa, a cupboard and a bookshelf, and say what is in front of me.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can name furniture, a sofa, a cupboard and a bookshelf, and say what is in front of me.*

175.1 jiājù — furniture

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ladder, then the Mandarin for a light bulb.

You'll want to know: jiājù

jiājù — "furniture".

> *wǒmen yào mǎi xīn jiājù* — We're going to buy new furniture.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiājù is built from 家 'home' and *jù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *gjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'complete' and 'to provide': what a home is provided with.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiājù*
- *Say it: jiājù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yào mǎi xīn jiājù* — We're going to buy new furniture.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ladder, then the Mandarin for a light bulb, then say *jiājù* again

Before you move on

What does jiājù mean? ("Furniture".) Say it once more.

175.2 shāfā — sofa

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a light bulb, then the Mandarin for furniture.

You'll want to know: shāfā

shāfā — "sofa".

wǒmen de shāfā hěn shūfu — Our sofa is really comfortable.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāfā is usually traced to English *sofa*: the two characters were chosen for their sound, not for what they mean.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāfā*
- *Say it: shāfā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de shāfā hěn shūfu* — Our sofa is really comfortable.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a light bulb, then the Mandarin for furniture, then say *shāfā* again

Before you move on

What does shāfā mean? ("Sofa".) Say it once more.

175.3 面前 (miànqián) — in front of someone; in someone's presence

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for furniture, then the Mandarin for a sofa.

You'll want to know: 面前

面前 — *miànqián* — "in front of someone; in someone's presence".

我面前有一杯茶 *wǒ miànqián yǒu yì bēi chá* — There's a cup of tea in front of me.

The new character, in pieces: 面 — nine strokes: a horizontal on top, a short stroke falling to the left, then a frame (a vertical, a horizontal that turns down), two verticals inside it, two short bars between them, and the bottom bar last. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

面前 (*miànqián*) is built from 面 'face' and 前 'before', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjienH* and *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to face' and 'the front': before one's face.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: miànqián*
- *Say it: miànqián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ miànqián yǒu yì bēi chá* — There's a cup of tea in front of me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for furniture, then the Mandarin for a sofa, then say *miànqián* again

Before you move on

What does 面前 mean? ("In front of someone; in someone's presence".) Say it once more.

175.4 面 — a bar, a short stroke, then a frame

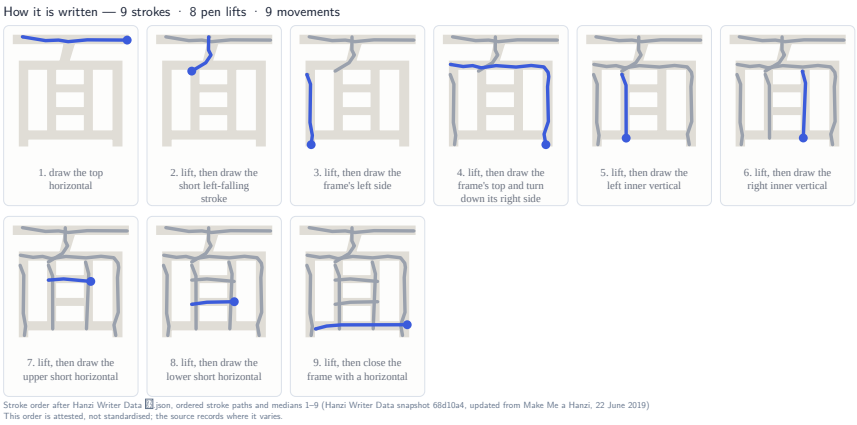
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *miànqián* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  前 日

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qián*, *rì*

Script — a bar, a short stroke, then a frame



How 面 *is written, stroke by stroke*

面

One piece, nine strokes, built from the outside in.

On top, two strokes. A horizontal across the top. A short stroke falling to the left under its middle.

The frame, two strokes. A vertical on the left. A horizontal along the top that turns down the right side.

The inside, four strokes. Two verticals. Then two short bars between them, one above the other.

Last, the bottom bar that closes the frame.

$2 + 2 + 4 + 1 =$ nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 面, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 面? (**Nine**.) What closes the frame? (**The bottom bar, last of all**.) What stands inside it? (**Two verticals, with two short bars between them**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 面, pinned stroke paths and medians.

175.5 guìzi — cupboard; cabinet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sofa, then the Mandarin for in front of someone.

You'll want to know: guìzi

guìzi — "cupboard; cabinet".

bēizi zài guìzi lǐ — The cups are in the cupboard.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guìzi is built from *guì* 'a chest' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gwijH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: guìzi*
- *Say it: guìzi*, once more
- *Say it: bēizi zài guìzi lǐ* — The cups are in the cupboard.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sofa, then the Mandarin for in front of someone, then say *guìzi* again

Before you move on

What does guìzi mean? ("Cupboard; cabinet".) Say it once more.

175.6 shūjià — bookshelf

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in front of someone, then the Mandarin for a cupboard.

You'll want to know: shūjià

shūjià — "bookshelf".

zhège shūjià hěn hǎokàn — This bookshelf looks nice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shūjià is built from 书 'book' and *jià* 'frame'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *syo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the second is listed there as *kaeH*, glossed as the frame of a house: a frame for books.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūjià*
- *Say it: shūjià*, once more
- *Say it: zhège shūjià hěn hǎokàn* — This bookshelf looks nice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in front of someone, then the Mandarin for a cupboard, then say *shūjià* again

Before you move on

What does shūjià mean? ("Bookshelf".) Say it once more.

175.7 Looking back: from Pots and Pans to Sofa and Shelves

Say the Mandarin for a cooking pot and a teacup.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a cooking pot, a teacup, a spoon, a fork, a microwave oven
- *Say it:* to switch on, an air conditioner, a remote control, to press a button, to touch
- *Say it:* a flavour, sour, bitter, smelling good, bland
- *Say it:* to invite, to send regards to, an evening party, a get-together, to pay for everyone
- *Say it:* to hang something up, to sort something out, to lift together, a ladder, a light bulb
- *Say it:* furniture, a sofa, in front of someone, a cupboard, a bookshelf
- *Read it:* 杯 候 面 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A cooking pot? (*guō.*) A teacup? (茶杯, *chábēi.*) A spoon? (*sháozi.*) A fork? (*chāzi.*) A microwave oven? (*wēibōlú.*) To switch on? (打开, *dǎkāi.*) An air conditioner? (*kōngtiáo.*) A remote control? (*yáokòngqì.*) To press a button? (*àn.*) To touch? (*pèng.*) A flavour? (*wèidao.*) Sour? (*suān.*) Bitter? (*kǔ.*) Smelling good? (*xiāng.*) Bland? (*dàn.*) To invite? (*yāoqǐng.*) To send regards to? (问候, *wènhòu.*) An evening party? (晚会, *wǎnhuì.*) A get-together? (*jùhuì.*) To pay for everyone? (请客, *qǐngkè.*) To hang something up? (*guà.*) To sort something out? (*nòng.*) To lift together? (*tái.*) A ladder? (*tīzi.*) A light bulb? (*dēngpào.*) Furniture? (*jiājù.*) A sofa? (*shāfā.*) In front of someone? (面前, *miànqián.*) A cupboard? (*guìzi.*) A bookshelf? (*shūjià.*)

Chapter 176

A Knock at the Door

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell what happened at home: a knock at the door, the neighbours quarrelling, something toppling over, a fire.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can tell what happened at home: a knock at the door, the neighbours quarrelling, something toppling over, a fire.*

176.1 qiāomén — to knock at the door

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a cupboard, then the Mandarin for a bookshelf.

You'll want to know: qiāomén

qiāomén — "to knock at the door".

> *zuótiān wǎnshang yǒu rén qiāomén* — Somebody knocked at the door last night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiāomén is built from *qiāo* 'to strike' and 門 'door', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaew* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiāomén*
- *Say it: qiāomén*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān wǎnshang yǒu rén qiāomén* — Somebody knocked at the door last night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a cupboard, then the Mandarin for a bookshelf, then say *qiāomén* again

Before you move on

What does qiāomén mean? ("To knock at the door".) Say it once more.

176.2 línjū — neighbour

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bookshelf, then the Mandarin for to knock at the door.

You'll want to know: línjū

línjū — "neighbour".

qiāomén de rén shì wǒ de línjū — The one knocking was my neighbour.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

línjū is built from *lín* 'near' and *jū* 'to dwell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lin* and *kjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the one who dwells near. After an older book, the dictionary also counts five households together as one *lín*.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: línjū*
- *Say it: línjū*, once more
- *Say it: qiāomén de rén shì wǒ de línjū* — The one knocking was my neighbour.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bookshelf, then the Mandarin for to knock at the door, then say *línjū* again

Before you move on

What does línjū mean? ("Neighbour".) Say it once more.

176.3 chǎojià — to quarrel; to have a row

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to knock at the door, then the Mandarin for a neighbour.

You'll want to know: chǎojià

chǎojià — "to quarrel; to have a row".

tā chángcháng gēn línjū chǎojià — He's forever quarrelling with the neighbours.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǎojià is built from 吵 'noisy' and *jià*. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsrhaewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a sound'; the second is the word for a frame, and how it came to mean a fight is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǎojià*
- *Say it: chǎojià*, once more
- *Say it: tā chángcháng gēn línjū chǎojià* — He's forever quarrelling with the neighbours.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to knock at the door, then the Mandarin for a neighbour, then say *chǎojià* again

Before you move on

What does chǎojià mean? ("To quarrel; to have a row".) Say it once more.

176.4 dǎo — to topple over; to fall down (of a thing)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a neighbour, then the Mandarin for to quarrel.

You'll want to know: dǎo

dǎo — "to topple over; to fall down (of a thing)".

tā de zìxíngchē dǎo le — His bike fell over.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *tawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to fall forward'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎo*
- *Say it: dǎo*, once more
- *Say it: tā de zìxíngchē dǎo le* — His bike fell over.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a neighbour, then the Mandarin for to quarrel, then say *dǎo* again

Before you move on

What does dǎo mean? ("To topple over; to fall down (of a thing)".) Say it once more.

176.5 zháohuǒ — to catch fire

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to quarrel, then the Mandarin for to topple over.

You'll want to know: zháohuǒ

zháohuǒ — "to catch fire".

qiántiān línjū jiā zháohuǒ le — The neighbours' house caught fire the day before yesterday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zháohuǒ is built from *zháo* 'to attach to' and 火 'fire', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjak* and *xwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): fire takes hold.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: zháohuǒ*
- *Say it: zháohuǒ*, once more
- *Say it: qiántiān línjū jiā zháohuǒ le* — The neighbours' house caught fire the day before yesterday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to quarrel, then the Mandarin for to topple over, then say *zháohuǒ* again

Before you move on

What does zháohuǒ mean? ("To catch fire".) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

Full Already

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what to order, ask for tofu, say I am full, and say whether food is fresh or tastes bad.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can ask what to order, ask for tofu, say I am full, and say whether food is fresh or tastes bad.*

177.1 tuījiàn — to recommend

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to topple over, then the Mandarin for to catch fire.

You'll want to know: tuījiàn

tuījiàn — "to recommend".

> *fúwùyuán nǐ tuījiàn shénme cài* — Waiter, which dish do you recommend?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuījiàn is built from *tuī* 'to push' and *jiàn* 'to put forward', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwoj* and *tsenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to present' and 'to put forward'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuījiàn*
- *Say it: tuījiàn*, once more
- *Say it: fúwùyuán nǐ tuījiàn shénme cài* — Waiter, which dish do you recommend?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to topple over, then the Mandarin for to catch fire, then say *tuījiàn* again

Before you move on

What does tuījiàn mean? ("To recommend".) Say it once more.

177.2 dòufu — tofu; bean curd

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to catch fire, then the Mandarin for to recommend.

You'll want to know: dòufu

dòufu — "tofu; bean curd".

wǒmen yào yí fèn dòufu — One portion of tofu for us, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dòufu is built from *dòu* 'beans' and *fu*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwH* and *bjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'rotten' and 'broken down': beans broken down into curd. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: dòufu*
- *Say it: dòufu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yào yí fèn dòufu* — One portion of tofu for us, please.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to catch fire, then the Mandarin for to recommend, then say *dòufu* again

Before you move on

What does dòufu mean? ("Tofu; bean curd".) Say it once more.

177.3 bǎo — full after eating; full up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to recommend, then the Mandarin for tofu.

You'll want to know: bǎo

bǎo — "full after eating; full up".

wǒ hěn bǎo bù chī le — I'm full: no more for me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎo is inherited from Middle Chinese *paewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to have eaten much'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎo*
- *Say it: bǎo*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ hěn bǎo bù chī le* — I'm full: no more for me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to recommend, then the Mandarin for tofu, then say *bǎo* again

Before you move on

What does bǎo mean? ("Full after eating; full up".) Say it once more.

177.4 xīnxiān — fresh

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tofu, then the Mandarin for full after eating.

You'll want to know: xīnxiān

xīnxiān — "fresh".

zhèr de yú gèng xīnxiān — The fish here is fresher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnxiān is built from *xīn* 'new' and *xiān* 'bright and clean', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *sjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnxiān*
- *Say it: xīnxiān*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de yú gèng xīnxiān* — The fish here is fresher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tofu, then the Mandarin for full after eating, then say *xīnxiān* again

Before you move on

What does xīnxiān mean? ("Fresh".) Say it once more.

177.5 nánchī — tasting bad; horrible to eat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for full after eating, then the Mandarin for fresh.

You'll want to know: nánchī

nánchī — "tasting bad; horrible to eat".

zhège cài bù xīnxiān hěn nánchī — This dish isn't fresh, and it tastes horrible.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nánchī is built from *nán* 'hard' and 吃 'to eat': hard to eat. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *nan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); for the second the dictionary has *khek*, glossed 'to eat', under another way of writing it, though *khek* would regularly give qì.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánchī*
- *Say it: nánchī*, once more
- *Say it: zhège cài bù xīnxiān hěn nánchī* — This dish isn't fresh, and it tastes horrible.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for full after eating, then the Mandarin for fresh, then say *nánchī* again

Before you move on

What does nánchī mean? (“Tasting bad; horrible to eat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

An Ordinary Day

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what is normal, talk about my days, then and lately, and the small hours.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say what is normal, talk about my days, then and lately, and the small hours.*

178.1 正常 (zhèngcháng) — normal; as usual

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fresh, then the Mandarin for horrible to eat.

You'll want to know: 正常

正常 — *zhèngcháng* — "normal; as usual".

> 没事我觉得很正常 *méishì wǒ juéde hěn zhèngcháng* — It's nothing: I think that's perfectly normal.

The new character, in pieces: 常 — eleven strokes: three short strokes on top, the cover piece of 学, 口 under it, and at the foot a frame with a long vertical down through it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

正常 (*zhèngcháng*) is built from 正 'right, proper' and 常, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengH* and *dzyang* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second as a length of two fathoms and as an official's title; the sense 'usual' is not given there, so how the pair came to mean normal is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngcháng*
- *Say it: zhèngcháng*, once more
- *Say it: méishì wǒ juéde hěn zhèngcháng* — It's nothing: I think that's perfectly normal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fresh, then the Mandarin for horrible to eat, then say *zhèngcháng* again

Before you move on

What does 正常 mean? ("Normal; as usual".) Say it once more.

178.2 常 — three strokes, a cover, 口 and a cloth

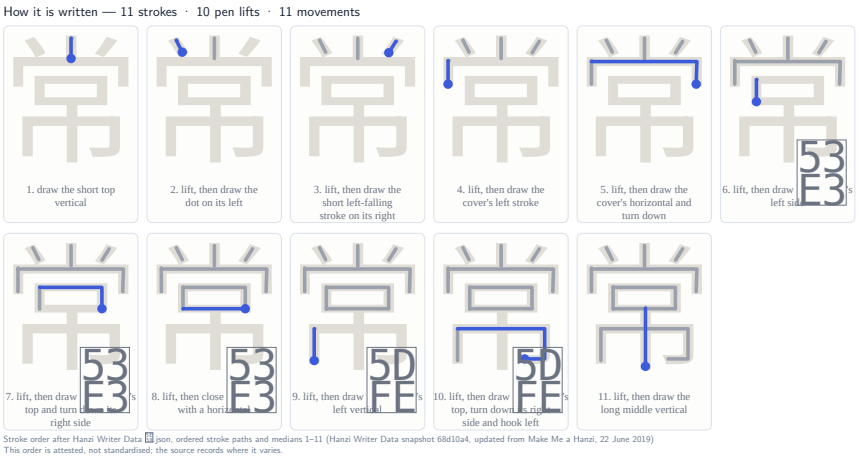
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhèngcháng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  学 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xué*, *kǒu*

Script — three strokes, a cover, 口 and a cloth



How 常 is written, stroke by stroke

常

Four pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

Three short strokes on top: a vertical in the middle, a dot to its left, and a short stroke on its right falling to the left.

Then the cover piece of 学, two strokes: a short stroke falling down on the left, then a horizontal that turns down and hooks.

Then 口, three strokes, as you write it.

At the foot, the cloth piece, three strokes: a short vertical on the left, a horizontal that turns down and hooks, and last a long vertical down through the middle.

3 + 2 + 3 + 3 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 常, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 常? (**Eleven**.) What sits under the cover? (口.) Which stroke comes last? (**The long vertical through the cloth piece**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 常, pinned stroke paths and medians.

178.3 日子 (rìzi) — day; days (of one's life)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for horrible to eat, then the Mandarin for normal.

You'll want to know: 日子

日子 — *rìzi* — "day; days (of one's life)".

小时候的日子很快乐 *xiǎoshíhou de rìzi hěn kuàilè* — My childhood days were happy.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

日子 (*rìzi*) is built from 日 'sun, day' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyit* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: rìzi*
- *Say it: rìzi*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou de rìzi hěn kuàilè* — My childhood days were happy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for horrible to eat, then the Mandarin for normal, then say *rìzi* again

Before you move on

What does 日子 mean? ("Day; days (of one's life)".) Say it once more.

178.4 从前 (cóngqián) — once upon a time; in the past

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for normal, then the Mandarin for one's days.

You'll want to know: 从前

从前 — *cóngqián* — "once upon a time; in the past".

我从前常常喝茶 *wǒ cóngqián chángcháng hē chá* — I used to drink a lot of tea.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

从前 (*cóngqián*) is built from 从 'from' and 前 'before', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjowng* and *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): from before.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: cóngqián*
- *Say it: cóngqián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ cóngqián chángcháng hē chá* — I used to drink a lot of tea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for normal, then the Mandarin for one's days, then say *cóngqián* again

Before you move on

What does 从前 mean? (“Once upon a time; in the past”.) Say it once more.

178.5 zuìjìn — lately; recently

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one’s days, then the Mandarin for once upon a time.

You’ll want to know: zuìjìn

zuìjìn — “lately; recently”.

nǐ zuìjìn máng ma — Have you been busy lately?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuìjìn is built from *zuì* ’most’ and *jìn* ’near’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tswajH* and *gj+nX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription): the nearest time.

What you’ve built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuìjìn*
- *Say it: zuìjìn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuìjìn máng ma* — Have you been busy lately?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one’s days, then the Mandarin for once upon a time, then say *zuìjìn* again

Before you move on

What does zuìjìn mean? (“Lately; recently”.) Say it once more.

178.6 língchén — the small hours; before dawn

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for once upon a time, then the Mandarin for lately.

You'll want to know: língchén

língchén — "the small hours; before dawn".

> *wǒ língchén sì diǎn qǐchuáng le* — I got up at four in the morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

língchén is built from *líng* and *chén*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ling* and *dzyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'ice' and the second 'early' and 'dawn'; how the first came into the word is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: língchén*
- *Say it: língchén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ língchén sì diǎn qǐchuáng le* — I got up at four in the morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for once upon a time, then the Mandarin for lately, then say *língchén* again

Before you move on

What does língchén mean? ("The small hours; before dawn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 179

Laundry Day

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the washing machine and powder, hanging things out, ironing and the wardrobe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can talk about the washing machine and powder, hanging things out, ironing and the wardrobe.*

179.1 洗衣机 (xǐyījī) — washing machine

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lately, then the Mandarin for in the small hours.

You'll want to know: 洗衣机

洗衣机 — *xǐyījī* — "washing machine".

> 我家有洗衣机 *wǒ jiā yǒu xǐyījī* — We've got a washing machine at home.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

洗衣机 (*xǐyījī*) is built from 洗 'to wash', 衣 'clothes' and 机 'machine', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejX*, *'j+j* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the last as the trigger of a crossbow, and 'machine' is a later sense.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐyījī*
- *Say it: xǐyījī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā yǒu xǐyījī* — We've got a washing machine at home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lately, then the Mandarin for in the small hours, then say *xǐyījī* again

Before you move on

What does 洗衣机 mean? ("Washing machine".) Say it once more.

179.2 xǐyīfěn — washing powder

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in the small hours, then the Mandarin for a washing machine.

You'll want to know: xǐyīfěn

xǐyīfěn — "washing powder".

xǐyīfěn méiyǒu le — We're out of washing powder.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐyīfěn is built from 洗 'to wash', 衣 'clothes' and *fěn* 'powder', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejX*, *'j+j* and *pjunX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), whose example for the last is a white powder made from lead.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐyīfěn*
- *Say it: xǐyīfěn*, once more
- *Say it: xǐyīfěn méiyǒu le* — We're out of washing powder.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in the small hours, then the Mandarin for a washing machine, then say *xǐyīfěn* again

Before you move on

What does xǐyīfěn mean? ("Washing powder".) Say it once more.

179.3 liàng — to hang out to dry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a washing machine, then the Mandarin for washing powder.

You'll want to know: liàng

liàng — "to hang out to dry".

jīntiān tiānqì hěn hǎo nǐ qù liàng yīfu — The weather's nice today: go and hang the washing out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liàng No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: liàng*
- *Say it: liàng*, once more

- *Say it: jīntiān tiānqì hěn hǎo nǐ qù liàng yīfu* — The weather's nice today: go and hang the washing out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a washing machine, then the Mandarin for washing powder, then say *liàng* again

Before you move on

What does liàng mean? ("To hang out to dry".) Say it once more.

179.4 yùn — to iron

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for washing powder, then the Mandarin for to hang out to dry.

You'll want to know: yùn

yùn — "to iron".

wǒ yào yùn yīfu — I'm going to do the ironing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùn is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to smooth silk with fire'. That reading would regularly give yù, so how today's yùn came about is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùn*
- *Say it: yùn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào yùn yīfu* — I'm going to do the ironing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for washing powder, then the Mandarin for to hang out to dry, then say *yùn* again

Before you move on

What does yùn mean? (“To iron”.) Say it once more.

179.5 yīguì — wardrobe

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hang out to dry, then the Mandarin for to iron.

You’ll want to know: yīguì

yīguì — “wardrobe”.

nǐ de dàyī zài yīguì lǐ — Your coat is in the wardrobe.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīguì is built from 衣 ’clothes’ and *guì* ’a chest’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *’j+j* and *gwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription).

What you’ve built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīguì*
- *Say it: yīguì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de dàyī zài yīguì lǐ* — Your coat is in the wardrobe.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hang out to dry, then the Mandarin for to iron, then say *yīguì* again

Before you move on

What does yīguì mean? (“Wardrobe”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

Coming Over

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about visiting as a guest, the host, calling on someone, coming over and making a date.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can talk about visiting as a guest, the host, calling on someone, coming over and making a date.*

180.1 做客 (zuòkè) — to visit as a guest; to be a guest

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to iron, then the Mandarin for a wardrobe.

You'll want to know: 做客

做客 — *zuòkè* — "to visit as a guest; to be a guest".

> 我去他家做客喝了两杯茶 *wǒ qù tā jiā zuòkè hē le liǎng bēi chá* — I went round to his place and had two cups of tea.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

做客 (*zuòkè*) is built from 做 'to do, to be' and 客 'guest'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'guest'; 做 has no form in that dictionary, so the history of the first part is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòkè*
- *Say it: zuòkè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù tā jiā zuòkè hē le liǎng bēi chá* — I went round to his place and had two cups of tea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to iron, then the Mandarin for a wardrobe, then say *zuòkè* again

Before you move on

What does 做客 mean? ("To visit as a guest; to be a guest".) Say it once more.

180.2 zhǔrén — host; owner

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a wardrobe, then the Mandarin for to visit as a guest.

You'll want to know: zhǔrén

zhǔrén — "host; owner".

zhǔrén hěn rèqíng — The host was very welcoming.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔrén is built from *zhǔ* 'to be in charge' and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuX* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the person in charge of the house.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔrén*
- *Say it: zhǔrén*, once more
- *Say it: zhǔrén hěn rèqíng* — The host was very welcoming.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a wardrobe, then the Mandarin for to visit as a guest, then say *zhǔrén* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔrén mean? ("Host; owner".) Say it once more.

180.3 kànwàng — to call on; to visit (a person)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to visit as a guest, then the Mandarin for the host.

You'll want to know: kànwàng

kànwàng — "to call on; to visit (a person)".

zhōumò wǒ qù kànwàng wǒ de lǎoshī — At the weekend I'm going to call on my teacher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kànwàng is built from 看 'to look' and *wàng* 'to gaze', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khanH* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second with this very word.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: kànwàng*
- *Say it: kànwàng*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒ qù kànwàng wǒ de lǎoshī* — At the weekend I'm going to call on my teacher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to visit as a guest, then the Mandarin for the host, then say *kànwàng* again

Before you move on

What does kànwàng mean? ("To call on; to visit (a person)".) Say it once more.

180.4 过来 (guòlai) — to come over

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the host, then the Mandarin for to call on someone.

You'll want to know: 过来

过来 — *guòlai* — "to come over".

你什么时候过来 *nǐ shénme shíhou guòlai* — When are you coming over?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

过来 (*guòlai*) is built from 过 'to pass' and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaH* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to pass over to here. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: guòlai*
- *Say it: guòlai*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shénme shíhou guòlai* — When are you coming over?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the host, then the Mandarin for to call on someone, then say *guòlai* again

Before you move on

What does 过来 mean? ("To come over".) Say it once more.

180.5 yuē — to arrange to meet; to make a date with

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to call on someone, then the Mandarin for to come over.

You'll want to know: yuē

yuē — "to arrange to meet; to make a date with".

wǒ yuē le péngyou xiàwǔ jiànmiàn — I've arranged to meet a friend this afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuē is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to bind' and 'sparing': to bind someone to a time.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuē*
- *Say it: yuē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yuē le péngyou xiàwǔ jiànmiàn* — I've arranged to meet a friend this afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to call on someone, then the Mandarin for to come over, then say *yuē* again

Before you move on

What does yuē mean? ("To arrange to meet; to make a date with".) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

Bed and Bath

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a quilt, a pillow, a bathroom and curtains, and count the rooms.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can name a quilt, a pillow, a bathroom and curtains, and count the rooms.*

181.1 bèizi — quilt; duvet

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come over, then the Mandarin for to make a date with.

You'll want to know: bèizi

bèizi — "quilt; duvet".

> *tiānqì lěng le wǒmen yào huàn bèizi* — It's turned cold: we need to change the quilt.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bèizi is built from *bèi* 'bedclothes' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjeX* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: bèizi*
- *Say it: bèizi*, once more
- *Say it: tiānqì lěng le wǒmen yào huàn bèizi* — It's turned cold: we need to change the quilt.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come over, then the Mandarin for to make a date with, then say *bèizi* again

Before you move on

What does bèizi mean? ("Quilt; duvet".) Say it once more.

181.2 zhěntou — pillow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a date with, then the Mandarin for a quilt.

You'll want to know: zhěntou

zhěntou — "pillow".

zhège zhěntou tài gāo le — This pillow is too high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhěntou is built from *zhěn* 'pillow' and *tóu* 'head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyimX* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); under its falling-tone reading the dictionary glosses the first with this very word. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhěntou*
- *Say it: zhěntou*, once more
- *Say it: zhège zhěntou tài gāo le* — This pillow is too high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a date with, then the Mandarin for a quilt, then say *zhěntou* again

Before you move on

What does zhěntou mean? ("Pillow".) Say it once more.

181.3 间 (jiān) — measure word for rooms

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a quilt, then the Mandarin for a pillow.

You'll want to know: 间

间 — *jiān* — "measure word for rooms".

后边有两间书房 *hòubian yǒu liǎng jiān shūfáng* — There are two studies at the back.

The new character, in pieces: 间 — seven strokes: the door piece 门, three strokes, and 日 inside it, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

间 (*jiān*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *kean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which writes it another way and glosses it 'a gap' and 'in between': the space between walls, and so a room.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiān*
- *Say it: jiān*, once more
- *Say it: hòubian yǒu liǎng jiān shūfáng* — There are two studies at the back.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a quilt, then the Mandarin for a pillow, then say *jiān* again

Before you move on

What does 间 mean? (“Measure word for rooms”.) Say it once more.

181.4 间 — 门 with 日 inside

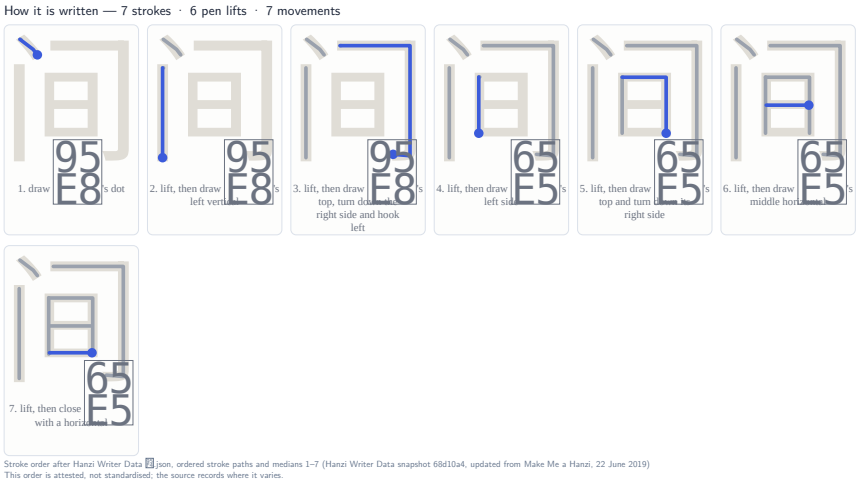
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  门 时

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *mén*, *shí*

Script — 门 with 日 inside



How 闻 is written, stroke by stroke

闻

Two pieces, the frame first. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

门, three strokes, as you write it: a dot, a vertical down the left, and a horizontal that turns down the right side and hooks.

Then 日 inside it, four strokes, as you write it, but smaller: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, a bar across the middle, and the bottom bar.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 闻, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 闻? (**Seven.**) Which piece comes first? (**门, the frame.**) What sits inside? (日.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 闻, pinned stroke paths and medians.

181.5 yùshì — bathroom

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pillow, then the Mandarin for measure word for rooms.

You'll want to know: yùshì

yùshì — "bathroom".

wǒmen jiā yǒu liǎng jiān yùshì — We have two bathrooms.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùshì is built from *yù* 'to bathe' and *shì* 'room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yowk* and *syit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùshì*
- *Say it: yùshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiā yǒu liǎng jiān yùshì* — We have two bathrooms.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pillow, then the Mandarin for measure word for rooms, then say *yùshì* again

Before you move on

What does yùshì mean? ("Bathroom".) Say it once more.

181.6 chuānglián — curtain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for measure word for rooms, then the Mandarin for a bathroom.

You'll want to know: chuānglián

chuānglián — "curtain".

wòshì de chuānglián hěn hǎokàn — The bedroom curtains are lovely.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuānglián is built from *chuāng* 'window' and *lián* 'a hanging screen', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhaewng* and *ljem* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a screen of thin strips.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuānglián*
- *Say it: chuānglián*, once more
- *Say it: wòshì de chuānglián hěn hǎokàn* — The bedroom curtains are lovely.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for measure word for rooms, then the Mandarin for a bathroom, then say *chuānglián* again

Before you move on

What does chuānglián mean? ("Curtain".) Say it once more.

181.7 Looking back: from A Knock at the Door to Bed and Bath

Say the Mandarin for to knock at the door and a neighbour.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to knock at the door, a neighbour, to quarrel, to topple over, to catch fire
- *Say it:* to recommend, tofu, full after eating, fresh, horrible to eat
- *Say it:* normal, one's days, once upon a time, lately, in the small hours
- *Say it:* a washing machine, washing powder, to hang out to dry, to iron, a wardrobe
- *Say it:* to visit as a guest, the host, to call on someone, to come over, to make a date with
- *Say it:* a quilt, a pillow, measure word for rooms, a bathroom, a curtain
- *Read it:* 常 间 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To knock at the door? (*qiāomén.*) A neighbour? (*línjū.*) To quarrel? (*chǎojià.*) To topple over? (*dǎo.*) To catch fire? (*zháohuǒ.*) To recommend? (*tuījiàn.*) Tofu? (*dòufu.*) Full after eating? (*bǎo.*) Fresh? (*xīnxiān.*) Horrible to eat? (*nánchī.*) Normal? (正常, *zhèngcháng.*) One's days? (日子, *rìzi.*) Once upon a time? (从前, *cóngqián.*) Lately? (*zuìjìn.*) In the small hours? (*língchén.*) A washing machine? (洗衣机, *xǐyījī.*) Washing powder? (*xǐyīfěn.*) To hang out to dry? (*liàng.*) To iron? (*yùn.*) A wardrobe? (*yīguì.*) To visit as a guest? (做客, *zuòkè.*) The host? (*zhǔrén.*) To call on someone? (*kànwàng.*) To come over? (过来, *guòlai.*) To make a date with? (*yuē.*) A quilt? (*bèizi.*) A pillow? (*zhěntou.*) Measure word for rooms? (间, *jiān.*) A bathroom? (*yùshì.*) A curtain? (*chuānglián.*)

Chapter 182

Eating Out

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about restaurants, cold starters, snacks, home cooking and boxed meals.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can talk about restaurants, cold starters, snacks, home cooking and boxed meals.*

182.1 fànguǎn — restaurant

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bathroom, then the Mandarin for a curtain.

You'll want to know: fànguǎn

fànguǎn — "restaurant".

> *wǒ jiā hòubian yǒu yí ge fànguǎn* — There's a restaurant behind our place.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fànguǎn is built from 饭 'meal' and *guǎn* 'lodging house', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjonH* and *kwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), though the falling tone of *kwanH* would regularly give guàn.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: fànguǎn*
- *Say it: fànguǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā hòubian yǒu yí ge fànguǎn* — There's a restaurant behind our place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bathroom, then the Mandarin for a curtain, then say *fànguǎn* again

Before you move on

What does fànguǎn mean? ("Restaurant".) Say it once more.

182.2 冷菜 (lěngcài) — cold starter; cold dishes (on a menu)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a curtain, then the Mandarin for a restaurant.

You'll want to know: 冷菜

冷菜 — *lěngcài* — "cold starter; cold dishes (on a menu)".

我们要两个冷菜 *wǒmen yào liǎng ge lěngcài* — We'd like two cold starters.

The new character, in pieces: 冷 — seven strokes: the ice piece on the left (a dot, then a stroke rising to the right), and on the right 今 as you write it, with one more dot under it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

冷菜 (*lěngcài*) is built from 冷 'cold' and 菜 'dish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lengX* and *tshojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'cold' and calls the second any

plant fit to eat; 'a dish' is the later sense. The dishes a meal starts with, served cold.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: lěngcài*
- *Say it: lěngcài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yào liǎng ge lěngcài* — We'd like two cold starters.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a curtain, then the Mandarin for a restaurant, then say *lěngcài* again

Before you move on

What does 冷菜 mean? ("Cold starter; cold dishes (on a menu)".) Say it once more.

182.3 冷 — the ice piece, then 今 and a dot

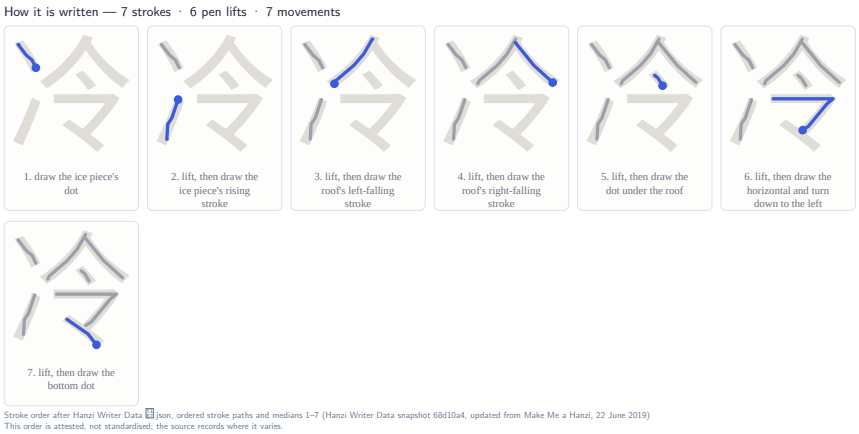
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lěngcài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

今 菜

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jīn*, *cài*

Script — the ice piece, then 今 and a dot



How 冷 is written, stroke by stroke

冷

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The ice piece, two strokes. A dot. Then, under it, a short stroke rising to the upper right.

The right piece, five strokes: 今, then a dot. 今 as you write it: a stroke falling to the left, one falling to the right, a dot under the roof, and a horizontal that turns and falls to the left. Last, one more dot under it.

2 + 4 + 1 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 冷, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 冷? (**Seven**.) How many in the ice piece? (**Two: a dot, then a rising stroke**.) Which character makes most of the right-hand piece? (**今, with one more dot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 冷, pinned stroke paths and medians.

182.4 小吃 (xiǎochī) — snack; street food

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a restaurant, then the Mandarin for a cold starter.

You'll want to know: 小吃

小吃 — *xiǎochī* — "snack; street food".

中午没有时间我们吃小吃 *zhōngwǔ méiyǒu shíjiān wǒmen chī xiǎochī* — There's no time at lunch, so we'll grab a snack.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小吃 (*xiǎochī*) is built from 小 'small' and 吃 'to eat': a small eat. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); for the second the dictionary has *khek*, glossed 'to eat', under another way of writing it, though *khek* would regularly give qì.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎochī*
- *Say it: xiǎochī*, once more
- *Say it: zhōngwǔ méiyǒu shíjiān wǒmen chī xiǎochī* — There's no time at lunch, so we'll grab a snack.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a restaurant, then the Mandarin for a cold starter, then say *xiǎochī* again

Before you move on

What does 小吃 mean? ("Snack; street food".) Say it once more.

182.5 家常菜 (jiāchángcài) — home cooking; everyday dishes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a cold starter, then the Mandarin for a snack.

You'll want to know: 家常菜

家常菜 — *jiāchángcài* — "home cooking; everyday dishes".

我们去对面吃家常菜 *wǒmen qù duìmiàn chī jiāchángcài* — Let's go across the road for some home cooking.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

家常菜 (*jiāchángcài*) is built from 家 'home', 常 'everyday' and 菜 'dish', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae*, *dzyang* and *tshojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the dishes a home makes every day. The everyday sense of the second is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāchángcài*
- *Say it: jiāchángcài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù duìmiàn chī jiāchángcài* — Let's go across the road for some home cooking.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a cold starter, then the Mandarin for a snack, then say *jiāchángcài* again

Before you move on

What does 家常菜 mean? ("Home cooking; everyday dishes".) Say it once more.

182.6 héfàn — boxed meal; packed lunch

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a snack, then the Mandarin for home cooking.

You'll want to know: héfàn

héfàn — "boxed meal; packed lunch".

wǒmen zhōngwǔ chī héfàn — We have boxed lunches at midday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

héfàn is built from *hé* 'box' and 饭 'meal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hop* and *bjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a dish with a lid.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: héfàn*
- *Say it: héfàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhōngwǔ chī héfàn* — We have boxed lunches at midday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a snack, then the Mandarin for home cooking, then say *héfàn* again

Before you move on

What does héfàn mean? ("Boxed meal; packed lunch".) Say it once more.

Chapter 183

In and Out

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about going out, coming in, finishing work, locking up and lying down.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can talk about going out, coming in, finishing work, locking up and lying down.*

183.1 出去 (chūqù) — to go outside; to go out of here

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for home cooking, then the Mandarin for a boxed meal.

You'll want to know: 出去

出去 — *chūqù* — "to go outside; to go out of here".

> 外边很冷你还要出去吗 *wàibian hěn lěng nǐ hái yào chūqù ma* — It's cold out: are you still going out?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出去 (*chūqù*) is built from 出 'to come out' and 去 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *khjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): out and away from here.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūqù*
- *Say it: chūqù*, once more
- *Say it: wàibian hěn lěng nǐ hái yào chūqù ma* — It's cold out: are you still going out?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for home cooking, then the Mandarin for a boxed meal, then say *chūqù* again

Before you move on

What does 出去 mean? ("To go outside; to go out of here".) Say it once more.

183.2 进来 (jìnlái) — to come inside; to come in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a boxed meal, then the Mandarin for to go out of here.

You'll want to know: 进来

进来 — *jìnlái* — "to come inside; to come in".

请进来你的房间在这儿 *qǐng jìnlái nǐ de fángjiān zài zhèr* — Come on in: your room is here.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

进来 (*jìnlái*) is built from 进 'to go in' and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsinH* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): in and towards here.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnlái*
- *Say it: jìnlái*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng jìnlái nǐ de fángjiān zài zhèr* — Come on in: your room is here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a boxed meal, then the Mandarin for to go out of here, then say *jìnlái* again

Before you move on

What does 进来 mean? ("To come inside; to come in".) Say it once more.

183.3 xiàbān — to finish work; to come off a shift

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go out of here, then the Mandarin for to come inside.

You'll want to know: xiàbān

xiàbān — "to finish work; to come off a shift".

nǐ jǐ diǎn xiàbān — What time do you finish work?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàbān is built from 下 'to go down' and *bān*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *paen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as dividing tokens of jade; the sense 'a shift at work' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàbān*
- *Say it: xiàbān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ jǐ diǎn xiàbān* — What time do you finish work?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go out of here, then the Mandarin for to come inside, then say *xiàbān* again

Before you move on

What does xiàbān mean? ("To finish work; to come off a shift".) Say it once more.

183.4 suǒmén — to lock the door; to lock up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come inside, then the Mandarin for to finish work.

You'll want to know: suǒmén

suǒmén — "to lock the door; to lock up".

chūqù yǐqián bié wàng le suǒmén — Don't forget to lock the door before you go out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suǒmén is built from *suǒ* 'a lock' and 門 'door', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *swaX* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'an iron lock'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: suǒmén*
- *Say it: suǒmén*, once more
- *Say it: chūqù yǐqián bié wàng le suǒmén* — Don't forget to lock the door before you go out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come inside, then the Mandarin for to finish work, then say *suǒmén* again

Before you move on

What does suǒmén mean? ("To lock the door; to lock up".) Say it once more.

183.5 tǎng — to lie down

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to finish work, then the Mandarin for to lock up.

You'll want to know: tǎng

tǎng — "to lie down".

wǒ hěn lèi xiǎng tǎng yíhuìr — I'm tired; I want to lie down for a bit.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǎng No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǎng*
- *Say it: tǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn lèi xiǎng tǎng yíhuìr* — I'm tired; I want to lie down for a bit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to finish work, then the Mandarin for to lock up, then say *tǎng* again

Before you move on

What does tǎng mean? ("To lie down".) Say it once more.

Chapter 184

Holiday Plans

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about going on holiday, deciding where, looking round places, my home town and relaxing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can talk about going on holiday, deciding where, looking round places, my home town and relaxing.*

184.1 dùjià — to go on holiday; to spend a holiday

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lock up, then the Mandarin for to lie down.

You'll want to know: dùjià

dùjià — "to go on holiday; to spend a holiday".

> *xià ge yuè wǒmen qù Běijīng dùjià* — Next month we're going on holiday to Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dùjià is built from *dù* and *jià* 'leave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duH* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The

dictionary glosses the second 'leave from duty' and the first 'a rule'; 'to spend time' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: dùjià*
- *Say it: dùjià*, once more
- *Say it: xià ge yuè wǒmen qù Běijīng dùjià* — Next month we're going on holiday to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lock up, then the Mandarin for to lie down, then say *dùjià* again

Before you move on

What does dùjià mean? ("To go on holiday; to spend a holiday".) Say it once more.

184.2 juédìng — to decide; a decision

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lie down, then the Mandarin for to go on holiday.

You'll want to know: juédìng

juédìng — "to decide; a decision".

wǒmen hái méi juédìng qù nǎr — We haven't decided where to go yet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

juédìng is built from *jué* and *dìng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwet* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary

glosses the first 'to cut off' and 'to break', and the second 'settled': to cut off and settle.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: juédìng*
- *Say it: juédìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen hái méi juédìng qù nǎr* — We haven't decided where to go yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lie down, then the Mandarin for to go on holiday, then say *juédìng* again

Before you move on

What does juédìng mean? ("To decide; a decision".) Say it once more.

184.3 cānguān — to look round a place; to visit (a sight)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go on holiday, then the Mandarin for to decide.

You'll want to know: cānguān

cānguān — "to look round a place; to visit (a sight)".

míngtiān wǒmen qù cānguān dàxué — Tomorrow we're going to look round the university.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cānguān is built from *cān* 'to present oneself' and *guān* 'to look', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshom* and *kwan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: cānguān*
- *Say it: cānguān*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǒmen qù cānguān dàxué* — Tomorrow we're going to look round the university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go on holiday, then the Mandarin for to decide, then say *cānguān* again

Before you move on

What does cānguān mean? ("To look round a place; to visit (a sight)".) Say it once more.

184.4 lǎojiā — home town; family home

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to decide, then the Mandarin for to look round a place.

You'll want to know: lǎojiā

lǎojiā — "home town; family home".

Chūnjié wǒ yào huí lǎojiā — I'm going back to my home town for the new year holiday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǎojiā is built from *lǎo* 'old' and 家 'home', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lawX* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the old home.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǎojiā*
- *Say it: lǎojiā*, once more
- *Say it: Chūnjié wǒ yào huí lǎojiā* — I'm going back to my home town for the new year holiday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to decide, then the Mandarin for to look round a place, then say *lǎojiā* again

Before you move on

What does lǎojiā mean? ("Home town; family home".) Say it once more.

184.5 fàngsōng — to relax; to loosen

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look round a place, then the Mandarin for one's home town.

You'll want to know: fàngsōng

fàngsōng — "to relax; to loosen".

wǒ xiǎng fàngsōng bù xiǎng chūqù — I want to relax; I don't feel like going out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàngsōng is built from *fàng* 'to let go' and *sōng* 'loose', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjangH* and *sowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as hair hanging loose.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàngsōng*
- *Say it: fàngsōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng fàngsōng bù xiǎng chūqù* — I want to relax; I don't feel like going out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look round a place, then the Mandarin for one's home town, then say *fàngsōng* again

Before you move on

What does fàngsōng mean? ("To relax; to loosen".) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

Long Ago and Soon

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say it has been ages, talk about before and after, mornings and evenings, and what tends to happen.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say it has been ages, talk about before and after, mornings and evenings, and what tends to happen.*

185.1 hǎojiǔ — a long time; ages

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's home town, then the Mandarin for to relax.

You'll want to know: hǎojiǔ

hǎojiǔ — "a long time; ages".

> *wǒmen hǎojiǔ méi jiànmiàn le* — We haven't seen each other for ages.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: hǎojiǔ is said háojiǔ, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎojiǔ is built from 好 'good', here 'very', and *jiǔ* 'long-lasting', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *kjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'lasting long'.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎojiǔ*
- *Say it: hǎojiǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen hǎojiǔ méi jiànmiàn le* — We haven't seen each other for ages.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's home town, then the Mandarin for to relax, then say *hǎojiǔ* again

Before you move on

What does hǎojiǔ mean? ("A long time; ages".) Say it once more.

185.2 zhīqián — before (a time); before (an event)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to relax, then the Mandarin for for ages.

You'll want to know: zhīqián

zhīqián — "before (a time); before (an event)".

chī fàn zhīqián yào xǐ shǒu — Wash your hands before you eat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhīqián is built from *zhī*, the old word that links a thing to what it belongs to, and 前 'before', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyi* and *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to go to'; the linking sense is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhīqián*
- *Say it: zhīqián*, once more
- *Say it: chī fàn zhīqián yào xǐ shǒu* — Wash your hands before you eat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to relax, then the Mandarin for for ages, then say *zhīqián* again

Before you move on

What does zhīqián mean? ("Before (a time); before (an event)".) Say it once more.

185.3 zhīhòu — after (a time); after (an event)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for for ages, then the Mandarin for before (a time).

You'll want to know: zhīhòu

zhīhòu — "after (a time); after (an event)".

xiàbān zhīhòu wǒ qù mǎi dōngxi — After work I'm going shopping.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhīhòu is built from *zhī*, the old linking word, and 后 'after', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyi* and *huwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhīhòu*
- *Say it: zhīhòu*, once more
- *Say it: xiàbān zhīhòu wǒ qù mǎi dōngxi* — After work I'm going shopping.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for for ages, then the Mandarin for before (a time), then say *zhīhòu* again

Before you move on

What does zhīhòu mean? ("After (a time); after (an event)".) Say it once more.

185.4 早晚 (zǎowǎn) — morning and evening; sooner or later

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for before (a time), then the Mandarin for after (a time).

You'll want to know: 早晚

早晚 — *zǎowǎn* — "morning and evening; sooner or later".

这儿早晚都很冷 *zhèr zǎowǎn dōu hěn lěng* — Here it's cold morning and evening.

Two third tones: zǎowǎn is said záowǎn, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

早晚 (*zǎowǎn*) is built from 早 'early' and 晚 'late', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsawX* and *mjonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): early and late, and so sooner or later.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǎowǎn*
- *Say it: zǎowǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr zǎowǎn dōu hěn lěng* — Here it's cold morning and evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for before (a time), then the Mandarin for after (a time), then say *zǎowǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 早晚 mean? ("Morning and evening; sooner or later".) Say it once more.

185.5 wǎngwǎng — more often than not; tends to

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for after (a time), then the Mandarin for morning and evening.

You'll want to know: wǎngwǎng

wǎngwǎng — "more often than not; tends to".

zhōumò wǒ wǎngwǎng shí diǎn qǐchuáng — At weekends I tend to get up at ten.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Two third tones: wǎngwǎng is said wángwǎng, the first rising.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǎngwǎng says one syllable twice. It is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to go'; how the doubled word came to mean 'more often than not' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for times of day.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎngwǎng*
- *Say it: wǎngwǎng*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒ wǎngwǎng shí diǎn qǐchuáng* — At weekends I tend to get up at ten.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for after (a time), then the Mandarin for morning and evening, then say *wǎngwǎng* again

Before you move on

What does wǎngwǎng mean? ("More often than not; tends to".) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

Odds and Ends

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name scissors, a rubbish bin, a plastic bag, a bottle and a drawer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can name scissors, a rubbish bin, a plastic bag, a bottle and a drawer.*

186.1 jiǎndāo — scissors

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for morning and evening, then the Mandarin for more often than not.

You'll want to know: jiǎndāo

jiǎndāo — "scissors".

> *jiǎndāo zài nǎr* — Where are the scissors?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎndāo is built from two parts inherited from Middle Chinese (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): *tsjenX*, glossed 'to cut off' and 'to make even', and *taw*, the word for a knife: a cutting knife.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎndāo*
- *Say it: jiǎndāo*, once more
- *Say it: jiǎndāo zài nǎr* — Where are the scissors?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for morning and evening, then the Mandarin for more often than not, then say *jiǎndāo* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎndāo mean? ("Scissors".) Say it once more.

186.2 lājītǒng — rubbish bin

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for more often than not, then the Mandarin for scissors.

You'll want to know: lājītǒng

lājītǒng — "rubbish bin".

lājītǒng mǎn le — The bin is full.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lājītǒng is built from *lājī* 'rubbish' and *tǒng* 'tub'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *thuwngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a wooden tub'; for *lājī* no dictionary we use records an older form, so the history of that part is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: lājītǒng*
- *Say it: lājītǒng*, once more
- *Say it: lājītǒng mǎn le* — The bin is full.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for more often than not, then the Mandarin for scissors, then say *lājītǒng* again

Before you move on

What does lājītǒng mean? ("Rubbish bin".) Say it once more.

186.3 sùliàodài — plastic bag

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for scissors, then the Mandarin for a rubbish bin.

You'll want to know: sùliàodài

sùliàodài — "plastic bag".

wǒ bú yào sùliàodài — I don't need a plastic bag.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sùliàodài is built from *sùliào* 'plastic' and *dài* 'bag'. Of its parts, *liào* 'material' and *dài* are inherited from Middle Chinese, *lew* and *dojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the first is listed there as *suH*, glossed 'a modelled figure': a material that can be modelled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: sùliàodài*
- *Say it: sùliàodài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bú yào sùliàodài* — I don't need a plastic bag.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for scissors, then the Mandarin for a rubbish bin, then say *sùliàodài* again

Before you move on

What does sùliàodài mean? ("Plastic bag".) Say it once more.

186.4 píngzi — bottle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a rubbish bin, then the Mandarin for a plastic bag.

You'll want to know: píngzi

píngzi — "bottle".

zhège píngzi lǐ yǒu shuǐ — There's water in this bottle.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píngzi is built from *píng* and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *beng* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a vessel for drawing water. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: píngzi*
- *Say it: píngzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège píngzi lǐ yǒu shuǐ* — There's water in this bottle.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a rubbish bin, then the Mandarin for a plastic bag, then say *píngzi* again

Before you move on

What does píngzi mean? ("Bottle".) Say it once more.

186.5 chōuti — drawer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a plastic bag, then the Mandarin for a bottle.

You'll want to know: chōuti

chōuti — "drawer".

jiǎndāo zài chōuti lǐ — The scissors are in the drawer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chōuti is built from *chōu* 'to pull out' and *ti* 'a tray'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *trhjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to pull out'; for the second no dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled. In the word it loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chōuti*
- *Say it: chōuti*, once more
- *Say it: jiǎndāo zài chōuti lǐ* — The scissors are in the drawer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a plastic bag, then the Mandarin for a bottle, then say *chōuti* again

Before you move on

What does chōuti mean? ("Drawer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

What a Day

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell what went wrong: something smashed, a fall, a regret, how things were then and how it ended.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can tell what went wrong: something smashed, a fall, a regret, how things were then and how it ended.*

187.1 dǎpò — to break; to smash

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bottle, then the Mandarin for a drawer.

You'll want to know: dǎpò

dǎpò — "to break; to smash".

> *zuótiān wǒ dǎpò le yí ge bēizi* — Yesterday I broke a glass.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎpò is built from 扌丁 'to strike' and *pò* 'to break', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *phaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), though dǎ is not the sound *taengX* would regularly give.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎpò*
- *Say it: dǎpò*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān wǒ dǎpò le yí ge bēizi* — Yesterday I broke a glass.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bottle, then the Mandarin for a drawer, then say *dǎpò* again

Before you move on

What does dǎpò mean? ("To break; to smash".) Say it once more.

187.2 shuāi — to have a fall; to drop (and break)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a drawer, then the Mandarin for to smash.

You'll want to know: shuāi

shuāi — "to have a fall; to drop (and break)".

tā shuāi le shǒu hěn téng — He had a fall, and his hand really hurts.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuāi No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuāi*
- *Say it: shuāi*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuāi le shǒu hěn téng* — He had a fall, and his hand really hurts.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a drawer, then the Mandarin for to smash, then say *shuāi* again

Before you move on

What does shuāi mean? ("To have a fall; to drop (and break)".) Say it once more.

187.3 hòuhuǐ — to regret

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to smash, then the Mandarin for to have a fall.

You'll want to know: hòuhuǐ

hòuhuǐ — "to regret".

> *wǒ hěn hòuhuǐ zuótiān méi qù wǎnhuì* — I really regret not going to the party yesterday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hòuhuǐ is built from 后 'after' and *huǐ* 'to repent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *xwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to repent and change'; today's third tone goes with its other reading, *xwojX*. To repent afterwards.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòuhuǐ*
- *Say it: hòuhuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn hòuhuǐ zuótiān méi qù wǎnhuì* — I really regret not going to the party yesterday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to smash, then the Mandarin for to have a fall, then say *hòuhuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does hòuhuǐ mean? ("To regret".) Say it once more.

187.4 dāngshí — at that time; then

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a fall, then the Mandarin for to regret.

You'll want to know: dāngshí

dāngshí — "at that time; then".

dāngshí wǒ bú zài jiā — I wasn't at home at the time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dāngshí is built from *dāng* and 时 'time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to match' and 'to meet with': the time it met with.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngshí*
- *Say it: dāngshí*, once more
- *Say it: dāngshí wǒ bú zài jiā* — I wasn't at home at the time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a fall, then the Mandarin for to regret, then say *dāngshí* again

Before you move on

What does dāngshí mean? ("At that time; then".) Say it once more.

187.5 jiéguǒ — in the end; as a result; a result

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to regret, then the Mandarin for at that time.

You'll want to know: jiéguǒ

jiéguǒ — "in the end; as a result; a result".

wǒmen děng le yí ge xiǎoshí jiéguǒ tā méi lái — We waited an hour, and in the end he didn't come.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiéguǒ is built from *jié* 'to tie' and *guǒ* 'fruit', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ket* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to set fruit, and so an outcome. The step to 'in the end' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiéguǒ*
- *Say it: jiéguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen děng le yí ge xiǎoshí jiéguǒ tā méi lái* — We waited an hour, and in the end he didn't come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to regret, then the Mandarin for at that time, then say *jiéguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does jiéguǒ mean? ("In the end; as a result; a result".) Say it once more.

187.6 Looking back: from Eating Out to What a Day

Say the Mandarin for a restaurant and a cold starter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a restaurant, a cold starter, a snack, home cooking, a boxed meal
- *Say it:* to go out of here, to come inside, to finish work, to lock up, to lie down
- *Say it:* to go on holiday, to decide, to look round a place, one's home town, to relax
- *Say it:* for ages, before (a time), after (a time), morning and evening, more often than not
- *Say it:* scissors, a rubbish bin, a plastic bag, a bottle, a drawer
- *Say it:* to smash, to have a fall, to regret, at that time, in the end
- *Read it:* 冷 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A restaurant? (*fànguǎn.*) A cold starter? (冷菜, *lěngcài.*) A snack? (小吃, *xiǎochī.*) Home cooking? (家常菜, *jiāchángcài.*) A boxed meal? (*héfàn.*) To go out of here? (出去, *chūqù.*) To come inside? (进来, *jìnlái.*) To finish work? (*xiàbān.*) To lock up? (*suǒmén.*) To lie down? (*tǎng.*) To go on holiday? (*dùjià.*) To decide? (*juédìng.*) To look round a place? (*cānguān.*) One's home town? (*lǎojiā.*) To relax? (*fàngsōng.*) For ages? (*hǎojiǔ.*) Before (a time)? (*zhīqián.*) After (a time)? (*zhīhòu.*) Morning and evening? (早晚, *zǎowǎn.*) More often than not? (*wǎngwǎng.*) Scissors? (*jiǎndāo.*) A rubbish bin? (*lājītǒng.*) A plastic bag? (*sùliàodài.*) A bottle? (*píngzi.*) A drawer? (*chōuti.*) To smash? (*dǎpò.*) To have a fall? (*shuāi.*) To regret? (*hòuhuǐ.*) At that time? (*dāngshí.*) In the end? (*jiéguǒ.*)

187.7 What a Day — once more

Say the Mandarin for to smash and to have a fall.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to smash, to have a fall, to regret, at that time, in the end

Before you move on

To smash? (*dǎpò.*) To have a fall? (*shuāi.*) To regret? (*hòuhuǐ.*) At that time? (*dāngshí.*) In the end? (*jiéguǒ.*)

Chapter 188

Money to Spend

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is well off, spend money or spend less, ask for change and say it is enough.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say someone is well off, spend money or spend less, ask for change and say it is enough.*

188.1 有钱 (yǒuqián) — rich; well-off

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at that time, then the Mandarin for in the end.

You'll want to know: 有钱

有钱 — *yǒuqián* — "rich; well-off".

> 他很有钱 *tā hěn yǒuqián* — He's very well off.

The new character, in pieces: 钱 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left the metal piece, five strokes; on the right two short bars, a long slanting hook, a stroke falling to the left across it, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

有钱 (*yǒuqián*) is built from 有 'to have' and 钱 'money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *dzjen* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the second, after an older commentary, as money named after a spring, because it flows everywhere.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒuqián*
- *Say it: yǒuqián*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn yǒuqián* — He's very well off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at that time, then the Mandarin for in the end, then say *yǒuqián* again

Before you move on

What does 有钱 mean? ("Rich; well-off".) Say it once more.

188.2 钱 — the metal piece, then two bars and a hook

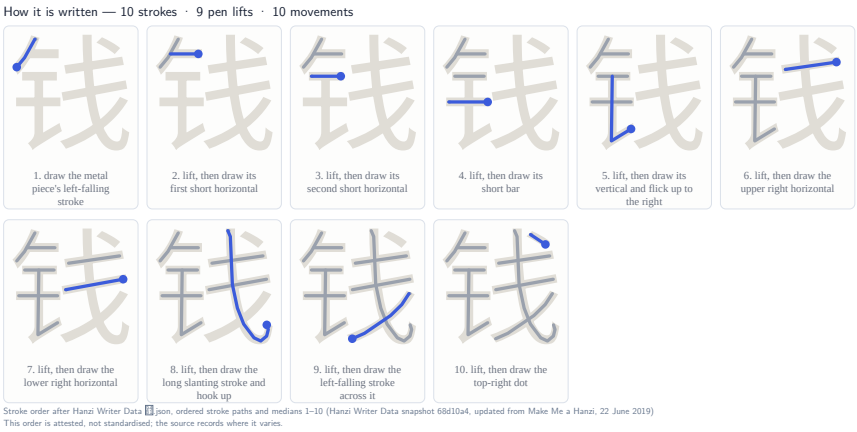
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yǒuqián* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  有 多

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yǒu*, *duō*

Script — the metal piece, then two bars and a hook



How 钱 *is written, stroke by stroke*

钱

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the metal piece, five strokes. A long stroke falling to the left, two short bars, a short bar rising to the right, then a vertical that turns up to the right at its foot.

The right piece, five strokes. Two short bars, one over the other. A long slanting hook from the top down to the lower right, flicking up at its foot. A stroke falling to the left across it. Then a dot at the top right.

5 + 5 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 钱, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 钱? (**Ten.**) What is the left piece? (**The metal piece, five strokes.**) What comes last? (**The dot at the top right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 钱, pinned stroke paths and medians.

188.3 huāqián — to spend money

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in the end, then the Mandarin for well-off.

You'll want to know: huāqián

huāqián — "to spend money".

wǒ mèimei hěn huì huāqián — My little sister really knows how to spend money.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huāqián is built from *huā*, the word for a flower, here 'to spend', and 钱 'money'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the first only as a flower, so how it came to mean spending is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: huāqián*
- *Say it: huāqián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mèimei hěn huì huāqián* — My little sister really knows how to spend money.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in the end, then the Mandarin for well-off, then say *huāqián* again

Before you move on

What does huāqián mean? ("To spend money".) Say it once more.

188.4 língqián — small change; loose coins

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for well-off, then the Mandarin for to spend money.

You'll want to know: língqián

língqián — "small change; loose coins".

nǐ yǒu língqián ma — Have you got any change?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

língqián is built from *líng* 'zero' and 钱 'money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *leng* and *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to fall' and 'a light rain'; the sense of small odd amounts is not given there, so how the pair came to mean change is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: língqián*
- *Say it: língqián*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu língqián ma* — Have you got any change?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for well-off, then the Mandarin for to spend money, then say *língqián* again

Before you move on

What does língqián mean? ("Small change; loose coins".) Say it once more.

188.5 shěngqián — to spend less; to save money

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to spend money, then the Mandarin for small change.

You'll want to know: shěngqián

shěngqián — "to spend less; to save money".

wǒ xiǎng shěngqián suǒyǐ bú qù fàndiàn — I want to save money, so I'm not going to restaurants.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shěngqián is built from *shěng* and 钱 'money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaengX* and *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as a government office; the sense 'to use less' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: shěngqián*
- *Say it: shěngqián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng shěngqián suǒyǐ bú qù fàndiàn* — I want to save money, so I'm not going to restaurants.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to spend money, then the Mandarin for small change, then say *shěngqián* again

Before you move on

What does shěngqián mean? ("To spend less; to save money".) Say it once more.

188.6 gòu — enough

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for small change, then the Mandarin for to spend less.

You'll want to know: gòu

gòu — "enough".

wǒ de qián bú gòu — I haven't got enough money.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gòu is inherited from Middle Chinese *kuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'many'. The dictionary lists it with a level tone only, so the falling tone of gòu is not the regular outcome, and how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: gòu*
- *Say it: gòu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de qián bú gòu* — I haven't got enough money.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for small change, then the Mandarin for to spend less, then say *gòu* again

Before you move on

What does gòu mean? ("Enough".) Say it once more.

Chapter 189

Forms and Dates

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the date, ask for a form, fill it in, sign it and show my identity card.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say the date, ask for a form, fill it in, sign it and show my identity card.*

189.1 号 (hào) — day of the month; number (in a series)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to spend less, then the Mandarin for enough.

You'll want to know: 号

号 — *hào* — "day of the month; number (in a series)".

> 今天是十月五号 *jīntiān shì shíyuè wǔ hào* — Today is the fifth of October.

The new character, in pieces: 号 — five strokes: 口 on top, then a long bar, and under it a stroke that goes down, turns right, turns down again and hooks to the left. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

号 (*hào*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *hawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to call', 'a command' and 'a title'. Numbering days and things is not given there, so how it came to that sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: hào*
- *Say it: hào*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān shì shíyuè wǔ hào* — Today is the fifth of October.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to spend less, then the Mandarin for enough, then say *hào* again

Before you move on

What does 号 mean? ("Day of the month; number (in a series)".) Say it once more.

189.2 号 — 口 on top, then a bar and a hook

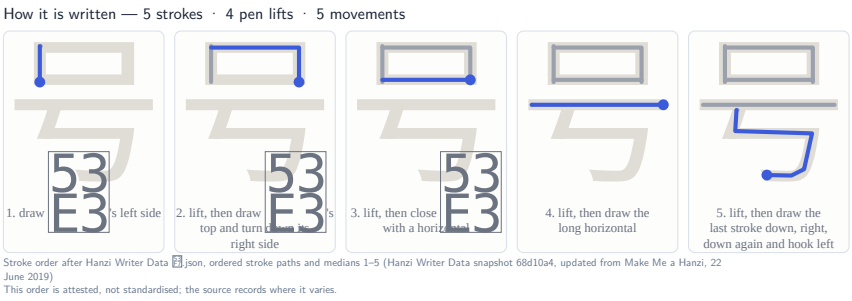
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *hào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

月 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yuè*, *kǒu*

Script — 口 on top, then a bar and a hook



How 号 is written, stroke by stroke

号

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, 口, three strokes, the same three as in 叫 and 吃: a short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, then the bar that closes the foot.

The bottom piece, two strokes. A long bar across the middle, wider than 口. Then, from under the bar, a short stroke down that turns right, turns down again and hooks to the left at its foot.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 号, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 号? (**Five.**) Which piece comes first? (**口, on top.**) Where does the last stroke hook? (**To the left, at its foot.**) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 号, pinned stroke paths and medians.

189.3 biǎogé — a form to fill in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for enough, then the Mandarin for day of the month.

You'll want to know: biǎogé

biǎogé — "a form to fill in".

> *qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng biǎogé* — Could I have a form, please?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biǎogé is built from *biǎo* and *gé*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjewX* and *kaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to make clear' and the second 'a pattern' and 'a measure'; how the pair came to mean a form to fill in is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: biǎogé*
- *Say it: biǎogé*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng gěi wǒ yì zhāng biǎogé* — Could I have a form, please?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for enough, then the Mandarin for day of the month, then say *biǎogé* again

Before you move on

What does biǎogé mean? ("A form to fill in".) Say it once more.

189.4 tiánxiě — to fill in (a form)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for day of the month, then the Mandarin for a form to fill in.

You'll want to know: tiánxiě

tiánxiě — "to fill in (a form)".

> *qǐng tiánxiě zhè zhāng biǎogé* — Please fill in this form.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiánxiě is built from *tián* 'to fill up' and *xiě* 'to write', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *den* and *sjaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to stop up' and 'full', and the second, among other senses, 'to copy out a book'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiánxiě*
- *Say it: tiánxiě*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng tiánxiě zhè zhāng biǎogé* — Please fill in this form.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for day of the month, then the Mandarin for a form to fill in, then say *tiánxiě* again

Before you move on

What does tiánxiě mean? ("To fill in (a form)".) Say it once more.

189.5 qiānmíng — to sign your name

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a form to fill in, then the Mandarin for to fill in.

You'll want to know: qiānmíng

qiānmíng — "to sign your name".

nǐ qiānmíng le ma — Have you signed it?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiānmíng is built from *qiān* 'to sign' and *míng* 'a name'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *mjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiānmíng*
- *Say it: qiānmíng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ qiānmíng le ma* — Have you signed it?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a form to fill in, then the Mandarin for to fill in, then say *qiānmíng* again

Before you move on

What does qiānmíng mean? ("To sign your name".) Say it once more.

189.6 shēnfènzhèng — identity card

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fill in, then the Mandarin for to sign your name.

You'll want to know: shēnfènzhèng

shēnfènzhèng — "identity card".

> *nǐ dài shēnfènzhèng le ma* — Have you brought your ID card?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēnfènzhèng is built from *shēn* 'oneself', *fèn* 'a share, a standing' and *zhèng* 'proof'. The first and the last are inherited from Middle Chinese, *syin* and *tsyingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'oneself' and 'to verify'; the dictionary gives the middle character another sound and sense, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnfènzhèng*
- *Say it: shēnfènzhèng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ dài shēnfènzhèng le ma* — Have you brought your ID card?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fill in, then the Mandarin for to sign your name, then say *shēnfènzhèng* again

Before you move on

What does shēnfènzhèng mean? ("Identity card".) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

Shops in Town

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the bookshop, the chemist's, the shopping centre, the cinema and the museum.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can name the bookshop, the chemist's, the shopping centre, the cinema and the museum.*

190.1 书店 (shūdiàn) — bookshop

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sign your name, then the Mandarin for identity card.

You'll want to know: 书店

书店 — *shūdiàn* — "bookshop".

> 这儿的书店很大 *zhèr de shūdiàn hěn dà* — The bookshops here are big.

The new character, in pieces: 店 — eight strokes: a roof of a dot, a bar and a long stroke falling to the left, and under it a vertical with a short stroke to its right, over 口. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

书店 (*shūdiàn*) is built from 书 'book' and 店 'shop', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syo* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription). The dictionary explains the second, after an older book, as a place where goods are set out for sale.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūdiàn*
- *Say it: shūdiàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de shūdiàn hěn dà* — The bookshops here are big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sign your name, then the Mandarin for identity card, then say *shūdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 书店 mean? ("Bookshop".) Say it once more.

190.2 店 — a roof over a small piece and 口

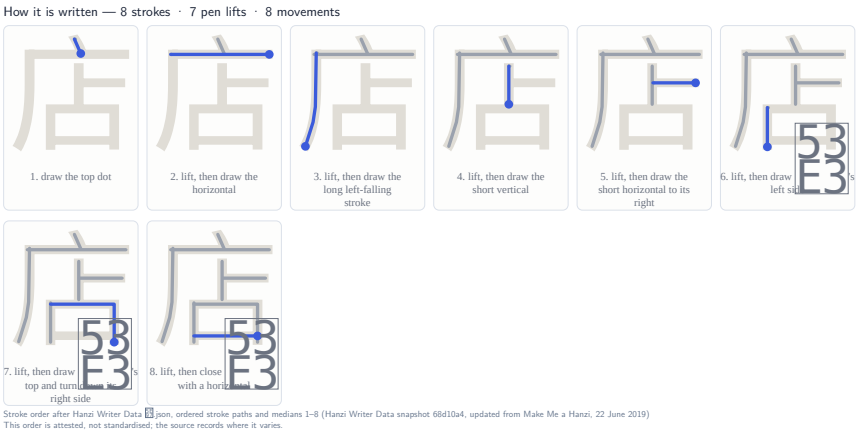
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shūdiàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  书 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shū*, *kǒu*

Script — a roof over a small piece and 口



How 店 *is written, stroke by stroke*

店

Three pieces: a roof, and under it a small piece over 口.

The roof, three strokes. A dot at the top, a bar across, then a long stroke from the left end of the bar, falling down to the left all the way to the foot.

The small piece, two strokes. A vertical under the roof, then a short stroke from its middle out to the right.

口, three strokes: a short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, then the bar that closes the foot.

3 + 2 + 3 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 店, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 店? (**Eight.**) Which stroke falls all the way to the foot? (**The third, the long one on the left.**) What closes

the character? (**The foot bar of 口.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 店, pinned stroke paths and medians.

190.3 yàodiàn — chemist's; pharmacy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for identity card, then the Mandarin for bookshop.

You'll want to know: yàodiàn

yàodiàn — "chemist's; pharmacy".

yàodiàn jǐ diǎn kāimén — What time does the chemist's open?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yàodiàn is built from *yào* 'medicine' and 店 'shop', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yak* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a herb that cures illness.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàodiàn*
- *Say it: yàodiàn*, once more
- *Say it: yàodiàn jǐ diǎn kāimén* — What time does the chemist's open?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for identity card, then the Mandarin for bookshop, then say *yàodiàn* again

Before you move on

What does yàodiàn mean? ("Chemist's; pharmacy".) Say it once more.

190.4 shāngchǎng — shopping centre

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bookshop, then the Mandarin for chemist's.

You'll want to know: shāngchǎng

shāngchǎng — "shopping centre".

zhōumò de shāngchǎng hěn rènao — The shopping centre is busy at the weekend.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāngchǎng is built from *shāng* 'trade' and *chǎng* 'an open ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syang* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second as a cleared ground for threshing grain, with a level tone, so the rising tone of chǎng is not the regular outcome; the sense 'trade' for the first is not given there either, so how both came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāngchǎng*
- *Say it: shāngchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò de shāngchǎng hěn rènao* — The shopping centre is busy at the weekend.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bookshop, then the Mandarin for chemist's, then say *shāngchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does shāngchǎng mean? ("Shopping centre".) Say it once more.

190.5 diànyǐngyuàn — cinema

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for chemist's, then the Mandarin for shopping centre.

You'll want to know: diànyǐngyuàn

diànyǐngyuàn — "cinema".

diànyǐngyuàn zài shāngchǎng lǐ — The cinema is inside the shopping centre.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diànyǐngyuàn is built from *diànyǐng* 'film' and *yuàn* 'a walled courtyard', the *yuàn* of *yīyuàn*; all three parts are inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH*, *'jaengX* and *hjwenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: diànyǐngyuàn*
- *Say it: diànyǐngyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: diànyǐngyuàn zài shāngchǎng lǐ* — The cinema is inside the shopping centre.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for chemist's, then the Mandarin for shopping centre, then say *diànyǐngyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does diànyǐngyuàn mean? (“Cinema”.) Say it once more.

190.6 bówùguǎn — museum

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for shopping centre, then the Mandarin for cinema.

You’ll want to know: bówùguǎn

bówùguǎn — “museum”.

bówùguǎn jīntiān bù kāimén — The museum is closed today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bówùguǎn is built from *bó* ’broad’, *wù* ’a thing’ and *guǎn* ’a lodging, a hall’, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *pak*, *mjut* and *kwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription): a hall of all kinds of things.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: bówùguǎn*
- *Say it: bówùguǎn*, once more
- *Say it: bówùguǎn jīntiān bù kāimén* — The museum is closed today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for shopping centre, then the Mandarin for cinema, then say *bówùguǎn* again

Before you move on

What does bówùguǎn mean? (“Museum”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 191

Back Next Month

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say when I will come back or go back, go home from abroad, go abroad or go away for work.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say when I will come back or go back, go home from abroad, go abroad or go away for work.*

191.1 回来 (huílái) — to come back

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cinema, then the Mandarin for museum.

You'll want to know: 回来

回来 — *huílái* — "to come back".

> 我下个月五号回来 *wǒ xià ge yuè wǔ hào huílái* — I'll be back on the fifth of next month.

The new character, in pieces: 回 — six strokes: a large frame, a small 口 inside it, and the bar that closes the large frame last. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

回来 (*huílái*) is built from 回 'to turn back' and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn round'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: huílái*
- *Say it: huílái*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xià ge yuè wǔ hào huílái* — I'll be back on the fifth of next month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cinema, then the Mandarin for museum, then say *huílái* again

Before you move on

What does 回来 mean? ("To come back".) Say it once more.

191.2 回 — 口 inside a larger frame

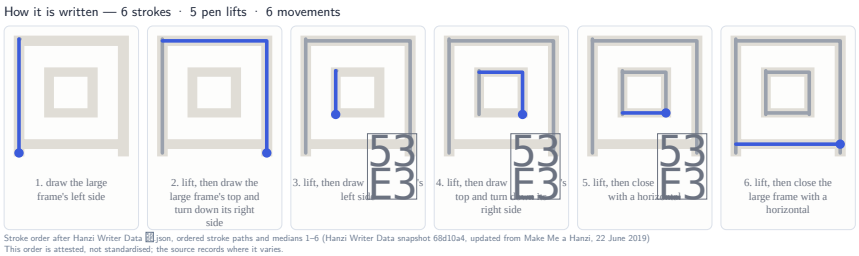
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *huílái* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  国 来

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *guó*, *lái*

Script — 口 inside a larger frame



How 回 is written, stroke by stroke

回

Two pieces: a large frame, and 口 inside it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The frame, first two strokes. A vertical down the left side, then a stroke along the top that turns down the right side.

口 inside, three strokes: a short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, and the bar that closes it.

Last, the frame's foot. One bar along the bottom closes the large frame, the way the last stroke of 国 does.

2 + 3 + 1 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 回, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 回? (**Six**.) What goes inside the frame? (口.) Which stroke comes last? (**The bar that closes the large frame**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 回, pinned stroke paths and medians.

191.3 回去 (huíqù) — to go back there

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for museum, then the Mandarin for to come back.

You'll want to know: 回去

回去 — *huíqù* — "to go back there".

我不想回去 *wǒ bù xiǎng huíqù* — I don't want to go back.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

回去 (*huíqù*) is built from 回 'to turn back' and 去 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *khjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to leave'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: huíqù*
- *Say it: huíqù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù xiǎng huíqù* — I don't want to go back.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for museum, then the Mandarin for to come back, then say *huíqù* again

Before you move on

What does 回去 mean? ("To go back there".) Say it once more.

191.4 回国 (huíguó) — to go home from abroad; to return to one's own country

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come back, then the Mandarin for to go back there.

You'll want to know: 回国

回国 — *huíguó* — "to go home from abroad; to return to one's own country".

他下星期回国 *tā xià xīngqī huíguó* — He's going back to his own country next week.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

回国 (*huíguó*) is built from 回 'to turn back' and 国 'country', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: huíguó*
- *Say it: huíguó*, once more
- *Say it: tā xià xīngqī huíguó* — He's going back to his own country next week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come back, then the Mandarin for to go back there, then say *huíguó* again

Before you move on

What does 回国 mean? ("To go home from abroad; to return to one's own country".) Say it once more.

191.5 出国 (chūguó) — to go abroad

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go back there, then the Mandarin for to go home from abroad.

You'll want to know: 出国

出国 — *chūguó* — "to go abroad".

我明年要出国 *wǒ míngnián yào chūguó* — I'm going abroad next year.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出国 (*chūguó*) is built from 出 'to go out' and 国 'country', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūguó*
- *Say it: chūguó*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ míngnián yào chūguó* — I'm going abroad next year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go back there, then the Mandarin for to go home from abroad, then say *chūguó* again

Before you move on

What does 出国 mean? ("To go abroad".) Say it once more.

191.6 chūchāi — to travel for work; to go on a business trip

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go home from abroad, then the Mandarin for to go abroad.

You'll want to know: chūchāi

chūchāi — "to travel for work; to go on a business trip".

bàba hòutiān yào chūchāi — Dad is going away on business the day after tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūchāi is built from 出 'to go out' and *chāi* 'an errand'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhwit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the second under several readings, glossed 'uneven' and 'to choose', and gives no errand, so how the word came to mean a work trip is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūchāi*
- *Say it: chūchāi*, once more
- *Say it: bàba hòutiān yào chūchāi* — Dad is going away on business the day after tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go home from abroad, then the Mandarin for to go abroad, then say *chūchāi* again

Before you move on

What does chūchāi mean? ("To travel for work; to go on a business trip".) Say it once more.

Chapter 192

Signs in a Building

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for the toilets, the lift and the car park, queue, and say when a place is open.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can ask for the toilets, the lift and the car park, queue, and say when a place is open.*

192.1 cèsuǒ — toilet; lavatory

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go abroad, then the Mandarin for to travel for work.

You'll want to know: cèsuǒ

cèsuǒ — "toilet; lavatory".

> *qǐngwèn cèsuǒ zài nǎr* — Excuse me, where's the toilet?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cèsuǒ is built from *cè* 'a privy' and *suǒ* 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhiH* and *srjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The modern *cè* is not the regular outcome of that form, and how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: cèsuǒ*
- *Say it: cèsuǒ*, once more
- *Say it: qǐngwèn cèsuǒ zài nǎr* — Excuse me, where's the toilet?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go abroad, then the Mandarin for to travel for work, then say *cèsuǒ* again

Before you move on

What does cèsuǒ mean? ("Toilet; lavatory".) Say it once more.

192.2 diàntī — lift; elevator

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to travel for work, then the Mandarin for lavatory.

You'll want to know: diàntī

diàntī — "lift; elevator".

diàntī huài le — The lift is out of order.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diàntī is built from 电 'electricity' and *tī* 'a ladder', the *tī* of *lóutī*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *thej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as wooden steps.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: diàntī*
- *Say it: diàntī*, once more
- *Say it: diàntī huài le* — The lift is out of order.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to travel for work, then the Mandarin for lavatory, then say *diàntī* again

Before you move on

What does diàntī mean? ("Lift; elevator".) Say it once more.

192.3 tíngchēchǎng — car park

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lavatory, then the Mandarin for lift (in a building).

You'll want to know: tíngchēchǎng

tíngchēchǎng — "car park".

shāngchǎng xiàbian yǒu yí ge tíngchēchǎng — There's a car park under the shopping centre.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tíngchēchǎng is built from *tíng* 'to stop', 车 'vehicle' and *chǎng* 'an open ground', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *deng*, *tsyhae* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíngchēchǎng*
- *Say it: tíngchēchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: shāngchǎng xiàbian yǒu yí ge tíngchēchǎng* — There's a car park under the shopping centre.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lavatory, then the Mandarin for lift (in a building), then say *tíngchēchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does tíngchēchǎng mean? ("Car park".) Say it once more.

192.4 páiduì — to queue; to line up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lift (in a building), then the Mandarin for car park.

You'll want to know: páiduì

páiduì — "to queue; to line up".

dàjiā dōu zài páiduì — Everyone is queuing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

páiduì is built from *pái* 'to set in a row' and *duì* 'a file of people'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a troop'; the dictionary glosses the first 'to push aside', so how it came to mean lining up is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: páiduì*
- *Say it: páiduì*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu zài páiduì* — Everyone is queuing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lift (in a building), then the Mandarin for car park, then say *páiduì* again

Before you move on

What does páiduì mean? ("To queue; to line up".) Say it once more.

192.5 kāifàng — to be open to the public

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for car park, then the Mandarin for to queue.

You'll want to know: kāifàng

kāifàng — "to be open to the public".

gōngyuán wǎnshang bù kāifàng — The park isn't open at night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāifàng is built from 开 'to open' and *fàng* 'to let go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *pjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāifàng*
- *Say it: kāifàng*, once more

- *Say it: gōngyuán wǎnshang bù kāifàng* — The park isn't open at night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for car park, then the Mandarin for to queue, then say *kāifàng* again

Before you move on

What does kāifàng mean? ("To be open to the public".) Say it once more.

Chapter 193

Prices Up and Down

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about special offers, prices going up and down, haggling and quality.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can talk about special offers, prices going up and down, haggling and quality.*

193.1 tèjià — special offer; reduced price

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to queue, then the Mandarin for to be open to the public.

You'll want to know: tèjià

tèjià — "special offer; reduced price".

> *jīntiān shuǐguǒ tèjià* — Fruit is on special offer today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tèjià is built from *tè* 'special' and *jià* 'price', the *jià* of *jiàqián*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dok* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a bull' and 'alone'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: tèjià*
- *Say it: tèjià*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān shuǐguǒ tèjià* — Fruit is on special offer today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to queue, then the Mandarin for to be open to the public, then say *tèjià* again

Before you move on

What does tèjià mean? ("Special offer; reduced price".) Say it once more.

193.2 jiàngjià — to get cheaper; to come down in price

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be open to the public, then the Mandarin for special offer.

You'll want to know: jiàngjià

jiàngjià — "to get cheaper; to come down in price".

diànnǎo jiàngjià le — Computers have got cheaper.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàngjià is built from *jiàng* 'to come down' and *jià* 'price', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngH* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go down' and 'to fall'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàngjià*
- *Say it: jiàngjià*, once more
- *Say it: diànnǎo jiàngjià le* — Computers have got cheaper.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be open to the public, then the Mandarin for special offer, then say *jiàngjià* again

Before you move on

What does jiàngjià mean? ("To get cheaper; to come down in price".) Say it once more.

193.3 zhǎngjià — to get dearer; to go up in price

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for special offer, then the Mandarin for to get cheaper.

You'll want to know: zhǎngjià

zhǎngjià — "to get dearer; to go up in price".

niúnǎi zhǎngjià le — Milk has gone up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǎngjià is built from *zhǎng* 'to rise' and *jià* 'price'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as water in flood, with a level and a departing tone only, so the rising tone of zhǎng is not the regular outcome, and its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎngjià*
- *Say it: zhǎngjià*, once more
- *Say it: niúnǎi zhǎngjià le* — Milk has gone up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for special offer, then the Mandarin for to get cheaper, then say *zhǎngjià* again

Before you move on

What does zhǎngjià mean? ("To get dearer; to go up in price".) Say it once more.

193.4 jiǎngjià — to haggle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get cheaper, then the Mandarin for to get dearer.

You'll want to know: jiǎngjià

jiǎngjià — "to haggle".

zhèr néng jiǎngjià ma — Can you haggle here?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎngjià is built from *jiǎng* 'to talk over' and *jià* 'price', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngX* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tell' and 'to discuss': to talk the price over.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎngjià*
- *Say it: jiǎngjià*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr néng jiǎngjià ma* — Can you haggle here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get cheaper, then the Mandarin for to get dearer, then say *jiǎngjià* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎngjià mean? ("To haggle".) Say it once more.

193.5 zhìliàng — quality

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get dearer, then the Mandarin for to haggle.

You'll want to know: zhìliàng

zhìliàng — "quality".

zhège hěn piányi zhìliàng yě hěn hǎo — It's cheap, and the quality is good too.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhìliàng is built from *zhì* 'substance' and *liàng* 'a measure', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyit* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'plain' and 'true', and the second as measuring grain.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhìliàng*
- *Say it: zhìliàng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège hěn piányi zhìliàng yě hěn hǎo* — It's cheap, and the quality is good too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get dearer, then the Mandarin for to haggle, then say *zhìliàng* again

Before you move on

What does zhìliàng mean? ("Quality".) Say it once more.

193.6 Looking back: from Money to Spend to Prices Up and Down

Say the Mandarin for well-off and to spend money.

Your turn

- *Say it:* well-off, to spend money, small change, to spend less, enough
- *Say it:* day of the month, a form to fill in, to fill in, to sign your name, identity card
- *Say it:* bookshop, chemist's, shopping centre, cinema, museum
- *Say it:* to come back, to go back there, to go home from abroad, to go abroad, to travel for work
- *Say it:* lavatory, lift (in a building), car park, to queue, to be open to the public
- *Say it:* special offer, to get cheaper, to get dearer, to haggle, quality
- *Read it:* 钱 号 店 回 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Well-off? (有钱, *yǒuqián.*) To spend money? (*huāqián.*) Small change? (*língqián.*) To spend less? (*shěngqián.*) Enough? (*gòu.*) Day of the month? (号, *hào.*) A form to fill in? (*biǎogé.*) To fill in? (*tiánxiě.*) To sign your name? (*qiānmíng.*) Identity card? (*shēnfènzhèng.*) Bookshop? (书店, *shūdiàn.*) Chemist's? (*yàodiàn.*) Shopping centre? (*shāngchǎng.*) Cinema? (*diànyǐngyuàn.*) Museum? (*bówùguǎn.*) To come back? (回来, *huílái.*) To go back there? (回去, *huíqù.*) To go home from abroad? (回国, *huíguó.*) To go abroad? (出国, *chūguó.*) To travel for work? (*chūchāi.*) Lavatory? (*cèsuǒ.*) Lift (in a building)? (*diàntī.*) Car park? (*tíngchēchǎng.*) To queue? (*páiduì.*) To be open to the public? (*kāifàng.*) Special offer? (*tèjià.*) To get cheaper? (*jiàngjià.*) To get dearer? (*zhǎngjià.*) To haggle? (*jiǎngjià.*) Quality? (*zhìliàng.*)

Chapter 194

Roads and Crossings

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about roads, going on foot, zebra crossings, squares and traffic lights.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can talk about roads, going on foot, zebra crossings, squares and traffic lights.*

194.1 马路 (mǎlù) — road; a street for traffic

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to haggle, then the Mandarin for quality.

You'll want to know: 马路

马路 — *mǎlù* — "road; a street for traffic".

> 我家在马路对面 *wǒ jiā zài mǎlù duìmiàn* — My home is across the road.

The new character, in pieces: 路 — thirteen strokes in two halves: on the left the foot piece, 口 over four short strokes; on the right a short fall, a bar that turns and falls to the left, a long stroke falling to the right, and 口 under them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

马路 (*mǎlù*) is built from 马 'horse' and 路 'road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maeX* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). Why a road for traffic is named after horses is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎlù*
- *Say it: mǎlù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā zài mǎlù duìmiàn* — My home is across the road.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to haggle, then the Mandarin for quality, then say *mǎlù* again

Before you move on

What does 马路 mean? ("Road; a street for traffic".) Say it once more.

194.2 路 — the foot piece, then three strokes over 口

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *mǎlù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  马 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *mǎ*, *kǒu*

Script — the foot piece, then three strokes over 口

How 路 *is written, stroke by stroke*

路

Two halves, left before right, and each has 口 in it.

The left half, the foot piece, seven strokes. 口 at the top, narrow. Under it a short vertical, a short bar from its middle to the right, a short vertical on the left, and a stroke along the foot that rises to the right.

The right half, six strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A bar that turns and falls down to the left. A long stroke falling down to the right. Then 口 underneath.

7 + 6 = thirteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 路, all thirteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 路? (**Thirteen**.) Where is 口 in the left half? (**At the top**.) And in the right half? (**At the bottom**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 路, pinned stroke paths and medians.

194.3 zǒulù — to walk; to go on foot

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for quality, then the Mandarin for a street for traffic.

You'll want to know: zǒulù

zǒulù — "to walk; to go on foot".

wǒ měitiān zǒulù qù shàngbān — I walk to work every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zǒulù is built from *zǒu* and 路 'road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsuwX* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to hurry'; in Mandarin it has come to mean walking.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǒulù*
- *Say it: zǒulù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān zǒulù qù shàngbān* — I walk to work every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for quality, then the Mandarin for a street for traffic, then say *zǒulù* again

Before you move on

What does zǒulù mean? ("To walk; to go on foot".) Say it once more.

194.4 bānmǎxiàn — zebra crossing; pedestrian crossing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a street for traffic, then the Mandarin for to go on foot.

You'll want to know: bānmǎxiàn

bānmǎxiàn — "zebra crossing; pedestrian crossing".

zhèr méiyǒu bānmǎxiàn — There's no zebra crossing here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bānmǎxiàn is built from *bānmǎ* 'zebra', literally a mottled horse, and *xiàn* 'a line'. 马 and *xiàn* are inherited from Middle Chinese, *maeX* and *sjenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists *bān* as *paen*, glossed 'mottled' and 'patterned': a crossing striped like a zebra.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: bānmǎxiàn*
- *Say it: bānmǎxiàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr méiyǒu bānmǎxiàn* — There's no zebra crossing here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a street for traffic, then the Mandarin for to go on foot, then say *bānmǎxiàn* again

Before you move on

What does bānmǎxiàn mean? (“Zebra crossing; pedestrian crossing”.) Say it once more.

194.5 guǎngchǎng — public square

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go on foot, then the Mandarin for zebra crossing.

You’ll want to know: guǎngchǎng

guǎngchǎng — “public square”.

huǒchēzhàn qiánbian yǒu yí ge guǎngchǎng — There’s a square in front of the station.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: guǎng is said with a rising tone before chǎng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǎngchǎng is built from *guǎng* ’wide’ and *chǎng* ’an open ground’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwangX* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’big’ and ’broad’.

What you’ve built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǎngchǎng*
- *Say it: guǎngchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchēzhàn qiánbian yǒu yí ge guǎngchǎng* — There’s a square in front of the station.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go on foot, then the Mandarin for zebra crossing, then say *guǎngchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does guǎngchǎng mean? (“Public square”.) Say it once more.

194.6 hónglǜdēng — traffic lights

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for zebra crossing, then the Mandarin for public square.

You’ll want to know: hónglǜdēng

hónglǜdēng — “traffic lights”.

lùkǒu yǒu hónglǜdēng hé bānmǎxiàn — There are traffic lights and a zebra crossing at the junction.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hónglǜdēng is built from *hóng* ’red’, *lǜ* ’green’ and *dēng* ’a lamp’, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwng*, *ljowk* and *tong* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription).

What you’ve built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: hónglǜdēng*
- *Say it: hónglǜdēng*, once more
- *Say it: lùkǒu yǒu hónglǜdēng hé bānmǎxiàn* — There are traffic lights and a zebra crossing at the junction.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for zebra crossing, then the Mandarin for public square, then say *hónglǜdēng* again

Before you move on

What does hónglǜdēng mean? (“Traffic lights”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

At the Bank

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can put money in and take it out, and talk about cards, PINs and bank accounts.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can put money in and take it out, and talk about cards, PINs and bank accounts.*

195.1 cúnqián — to put money by; to put money in the bank

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for public square, then the Mandarin for traffic lights.

You'll want to know: cúnqián

cúnqián — "to put money by; to put money in the bank".

> *wǒ měi ge yuè dōu cúnqián* — I put money aside every month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cúnqián is built from *cún* 'to keep' and 钱 'money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzwon* and *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to be present' and 'to care for'; putting money away is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: cúnqián*
- *Say it: cúnqián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měi ge yuè dōu cúnqián* — I put money aside every month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for public square, then the Mandarin for traffic lights, then say *cúnqián* again

Before you move on

What does cúnqián mean? ("To put money by; to put money in the bank".) Say it once more.

195.2 qǔqián — to take out money

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for traffic lights, then the Mandarin for to put money by.

You'll want to know: qǔqián

qǔqián — "to take out money".

wǒ yào qù yínháng qǔqián — I'm going to the bank to get some money out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qǔqián is built from *qǔ* 'to take' and 钱 'money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjuX* and *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to gather in' and 'to receive'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǔqián*
- *Say it: qǔqián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào qù yínháng qǔqián* — I'm going to the bank to get some money out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for traffic lights, then the Mandarin for to put money by, then say *qǔqián* again

Before you move on

What does qǔqián mean? ("To take out money".) Say it once more.

195.3 xìnyòngkǎ — credit card

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put money by, then the Mandarin for to take out money.

You'll want to know: xìnyòngkǎ

xìnyòngkǎ — "credit card".

zhèr kěyǐ yòng xìnyòngkǎ ma — Can I pay by credit card here?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìnyòngkǎ is built from *xìnyòng* 'trust, credit' and *kǎ* 'a card'. The first two parts are inherited from Middle Chinese, *sinH* and *youngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'true' and 'to use'; *kǎ* is usually traced to English *card*.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìnyòngkǎ*
- *Say it: xìnyòngkǎ*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr kěyǐ yòng xìnyòngkǎ ma* — Can I pay by credit card here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put money by, then the Mandarin for to take out money, then say *xìnyòngkǎ* again

Before you move on

What does xìnyòngkǎ mean? ("Credit card".) Say it once more.

195.4 mìmǎ — password; PIN

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take out money, then the Mandarin for credit card.

You'll want to know: mìmǎ

mìmǎ — "password; PIN".

wǒ wàngle mìmǎ — I've forgotten my PIN.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mìmǎ is built from *mì* 'secret' and *mǎ* 'a numeral', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mit* and *maeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a ridge' and 'quiet', and the second as a stone like jade; how they came to mean secret and a number sign is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: mìmǎ*
- *Say it: mìmǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wàngle mìmǎ* — I've forgotten my PIN.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take out money, then the Mandarin for credit card, then say *mìmǎ* again

Before you move on

What does mìmǎ mean? ("Password; PIN".) Say it once more.

195.5 zhànghù — bank account

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for credit card, then the Mandarin for password.

You'll want to know: zhànghù

zhànghù — "bank account".

nǐ yǒu yínháng zhànghù ma — Do you have a bank account?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhànghù is built from *zhàng* 'accounts' and *hù* 'a household'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *huX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as a door, half of a gate; no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhànghù*
- *Say it: zhànghù*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu yínháng zhànghù ma* — Do you have a bank account?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for credit card, then the Mandarin for password, then say *zhànghù* again

Before you move on

What does zhànghù mean? ("Bank account".) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

Tickets and Flights

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can buy a train ticket and a plane ticket, and say when a flight takes off and when a train arrives.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can buy a train ticket and a plane ticket, and say when a flight takes off and when a train arrives.*

196.1 车票 (chēpiào) — train or bus ticket

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for password, then the Mandarin for bank account.

You'll want to know: 车票

车票 — *chēpiào* — "train or bus ticket".

> 车票多少钱 *chēpiào duōshao qián* — How much is the ticket?

The new character, in pieces: 票 — eleven strokes: on top a bar over a frame with two short verticals; under it 二, a hooked vertical and two dots. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

车票 (*chēpiào*) is built from 车 'vehicle' and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the

second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēpiào*
- *Say it: chēpiào*, once more
- *Say it: chēpiào duōshao qián* — How much is the ticket?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for password, then the Mandarin for bank account, then say *chēpiào* again

Before you move on

What does 车票 mean? ("Train or bus ticket".) Say it once more.

196.2 票 — a framed top over 二 and three strokes

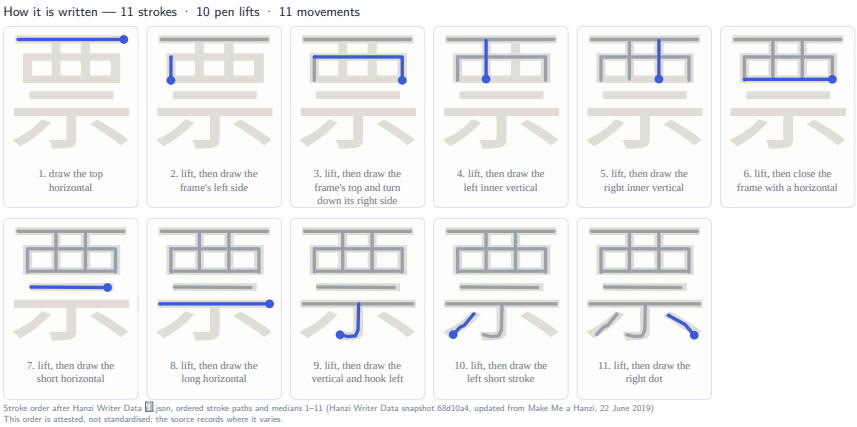
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chēpiào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  车 二

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *chē*, *èr*

Script — a framed top over 二 and three strokes



How 票 *is written, stroke by stroke*

票

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, six strokes. A bar across the top. Then a frame under it: a short vertical on the left, a stroke along the top that turns down the right side, two short verticals down through the top of the frame, and a bar that closes it.

The bottom piece, five strokes. 二: a short bar, then a longer one. A vertical down the middle that hooks to the left at its foot. A dot falling to the left, then a dot falling to the right.

6 + 5 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 票, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 票? (**Eleven**.) What starts the bottom piece? (二.) What sits either side of the hooked vertical? (**Two dots**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 票, pinned stroke paths and medians.

196.3 机票 (jīpiào) — plane ticket

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bank account, then the Mandarin for train or bus ticket.

You'll want to know: 机票

机票 — *jīpiào* — "plane ticket".

我买了十号的机票 *wǒ mǎile shí hào de jīpiào* — I've bought a plane ticket for the tenth.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

机票 (*jīpiào*) is built from 机, short for *fēijī* 'aeroplane', and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīpiào*
- *Say it: jīpiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎile shí hào de jīpiào* — I've bought a plane ticket for the tenth.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bank account, then the Mandarin for train or bus ticket, then say *jīpiào* again

Before you move on

What does 机票 mean? ("Plane ticket".) Say it once more.

196.4 hángbān — scheduled flight

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for train or bus ticket, then the Mandarin for plane ticket.

You'll want to know: hángbān

hángbān — "scheduled flight".

> *zhège hángbān wǎndiǎn le* — This flight is delayed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hángbān is built from *háng* 'to sail' and *bān* 'a shift, a set run', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hang* and *paen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a boat' and the second as dividing jade tokens; how the pair came to mean a flight is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: hángbān*
- *Say it: hángbān*, once more
- *Say it: zhège hángbān wǎndiǎn le* — This flight is delayed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for train or bus ticket, then the Mandarin for plane ticket, then say *hángbān* again

Before you move on

What does hángbān mean? ("Scheduled flight".) Say it once more.

196.5 qǐfēi — to take off (of a plane)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for plane ticket, then the Mandarin for scheduled flight.

You'll want to know: qǐfēi

qǐfēi — "to take off (of a plane)".

fēijī shí diǎn qǐfēi — The plane takes off at ten.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qǐfēi is built from 起 'to rise' and *fēi* 'to fly', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khiX* and *pj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐfēi*
- *Say it: qǐfēi*, once more
- *Say it: fēijī shí diǎn qǐfēi* — The plane takes off at ten.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for plane ticket, then the Mandarin for scheduled flight, then say *qǐfēi* again

Before you move on

What does qǐfēi mean? ("To take off (of a plane)".) Say it once more.

196.6 dàodá — to reach a destination; to arrive

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for scheduled flight, then the Mandarin for to take off.

You'll want to know: dàodá

dàodá — "to reach a destination; to arrive".

huǒchē xiàwǔ sān diǎn dàodá — The train arrives at three in the afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàodá is built from 到 'to arrive' and *dá* 'to get through', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tawH* and *dat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàodá*
- *Say it: dàodá*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē xiàwǔ sān diǎn dàodá* — The train arrives at three in the afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for scheduled flight, then the Mandarin for to take off, then say *dàodá* again

Before you move on

What does dàodá mean? ("To reach a destination; to arrive".) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

Finding the Way

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask the way, say I have found a place or got lost, and go straight on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can ask the way, say I have found a place or got lost, and go straight on.*

197.1 问路 (wènlù) — to ask the way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take off, then the Mandarin for to reach a destination.

You'll want to know: 问路

问路 — *wènlù* — "to ask the way".

他在问路 *tā zài wènlù* — He's asking the way.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

问路 (*wènlù*) is built from 问 'to ask' and 路 'road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjunH* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: wènlù*
- *Say it: wènlù*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài wènlù* — He's asking the way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take off, then the Mandarin for to reach a destination, then say *wènlù* again

Before you move on

What does 问路 mean? ("To ask the way".) Say it once more.

197.2 找到 (zhǎodào) — to find

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to reach a destination, then the Mandarin for to ask the way.

You'll want to know: 找到

找到 — *zhǎodào* — "to find".

我找到书店了 *wǒ zhǎodào shūdiàn le* — I've found the bookshop.

The new character, in pieces: 找 — seven strokes: on the left the hand piece of 打; on the right a bar, a long slanting hook, a stroke falling to the left across it, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

找到 (*zhǎodào*) is built from 找 'to look for' and 到 'to arrive': looking that gets there. 到 is inherited from Middle Chinese *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of 找, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎodào*
- *Say it: zhǎodào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhǎodào shūdiàn le* — I've found the bookshop.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to reach a destination, then the Mandarin for to ask the way, then say *zhǎodào* again

Before you move on

What does 找到 mean? ("To find".) Say it once more.

197.3 找 — the hand piece, then a hook and a fall

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhǎodào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  打 钱

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dǎ*, *qián*

Script — the hand piece, then a hook and a fall

How 找 is written, stroke by stroke

找

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, the hand piece, three strokes, the same three as in 打: a short bar, a vertical that hooks to the left at its foot, then a stroke rising to the right across it.

The right piece, four strokes. A bar. A long slanting hook from the top down to the lower right, flicking up at its foot. A stroke falling to the left across it. Then a dot at the top right.

3 + 4 = seven. The right piece is the right piece of 钱 with one bar fewer.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 找, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 找? (**Seven**.) Where has your hand made the left piece before? (**In 打**.) What comes last? (**The dot at the top right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 找, pinned stroke paths and medians.

197.4 mílù — to lose your way; to get lost

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ask the way, then the Mandarin for to find.

You'll want to know: mílù

mílù — "to lose your way; to get lost".

wǒ mílù le — I'm lost.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mílù is built from *mí* 'confused' and 路 'road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mej* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be bewildered'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: mílù*
- *Say it: mílù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mílù le* — I'm lost.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ask the way, then the Mandarin for to find, then say *mílù* again

Before you move on

What does mílù mean? ("To lose your way; to get lost".) Say it once more.

197.5 yìzhí — straight on; all the way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to find, then the Mandarin for to lose your way.

You'll want to know: yìzhí

yìzhí — "straight on; all the way".

cóng zhèr yìzhí zǒu — Go straight on from here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
— changes its tone here: yì, before the rising tone of zhí.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìzhí is built from 一 'one' and *zhí* 'straight', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *drik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'upright'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìzhí*
- *Say it: yìzhí*, once more
- *Say it: cóng zhèr yìzhí zǒu* — Go straight on from here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to find, then the Mandarin for to lose your way, then say *yìzhí* again

Before you move on

What does yìzhí mean? ("Straight on; all the way".) Say it once more.

197.6 lùxiàn — route

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lose your way, then the Mandarin for straight on.

You'll want to know: lùxiàn

lùxiàn — "route".

qù jīchǎng de lùxiàn hěn jiǎndān — The route to the airport is simple.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lùxiàn is built from 路 'road' and *xiàn* 'a line', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luH* and *sjenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'thread'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùxiàn*
- *Say it: lùxiàn*, once more
- *Say it: qù jīchǎng de lùxiàn hěn jiǎndān* — The route to the airport is simple.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lose your way, then the Mandarin for straight on, then say *lùxiàn* again

Before you move on

What does lùxiàn mean? ("Route".) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

Phones and Messages

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can switch a phone off and on, leave a message, and say the line is engaged or there is no signal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can switch a phone off and on, leave a message, and say the line is engaged or there is no signal.*

198.1 关机 (guānjī) — to switch off (a phone or a computer)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for straight on, then the Mandarin for route.

You'll want to know: 关机

关机 — *guānjī* — "to switch off (a phone or a computer)".

> 我的手机关机了 *wǒ de shǒujī guānjī le* — My phone is switched off.

The new character, in pieces: 关 — six strokes: two short strokes leaning toward each other, then 天 underneath. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

关机 (*guānjī*) is built from 关 'to shut' and 机 'machine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaen* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the bar that shuts a door, and explains the second as the catch that sets off a crossbow.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānjī*
- *Say it: guānjī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shǒujī guānjī le* — My phone is switched off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for straight on, then the Mandarin for route, then say *guānjī* again

Before you move on

What does 关机 mean? ("To switch off (a phone or a computer)".) Say it once more.

198.2 关 — two short strokes over 天

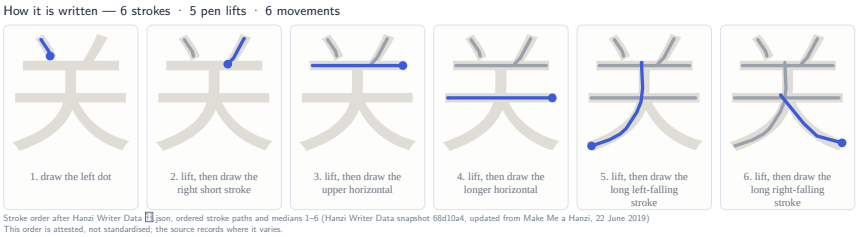
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *guānjī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  开 天

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kāi*, *tiān*

Script — two short strokes over 天



How 关 is written, stroke by stroke

关

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, two strokes. A dot on the left, falling to the lower right, then a short stroke on the right, falling to the lower left: the two lean toward each other.

The bottom piece, 天, four strokes: a bar, a longer bar, a long stroke falling to the left, and a long stroke falling to the right.

2 + 4 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 关, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 关? (**Six**.) Which character is the bottom piece? (天.) Which way do the two top strokes lean? (**Toward each other**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 关, pinned stroke paths and medians.

198.3 开机 (kāijī) — to turn a phone on; to switch on a phone or a computer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for route, then the Mandarin for to switch off.

You'll want to know: 开机

开机 — *kāijī* — "to turn a phone on; to switch on a phone or a computer".

> 你开机了吗 *nǐ kāijī le ma* — Have you switched your phone on?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开机 (*kāijī*) is built from 开 'to open' and 机 'machine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāijī*
- *Say it: kāijī*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ kāijī le ma* — Have you switched your phone on?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for route, then the Mandarin for to switch off, then say *kāijī* again

Before you move on

What does 开机 mean? ("To turn a phone on; to switch on a phone or a computer".) Say it once more.

198.4 liúyán — to leave a message

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to switch off, then the Mandarin for to turn a phone on.

You'll want to know: liúyán

liúyán — "to leave a message".

> *tā bú zài nǐ kěyǐ liúyán* — He isn't in, but you can leave a message.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúyán is built from *liú* 'to leave behind' and *yán* 'words', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *ngjon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stay' and 'to stop', and the second 'speech'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúyán*
- *Say it: liúyán*, once more
- *Say it: tā bú zài nǐ kěyǐ liúyán* — He isn't in, but you can leave a message.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to switch off, then the Mandarin for to turn a phone on, then say *liúyán* again

Before you move on

What does liúyán mean? ("To leave a message".) Say it once more.

198.5 zhànxiàn — engaged; busy (of a phone line)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn a phone on, then the Mandarin for to leave a message.

You'll want to know: zhànxiàn

zhànxiàn — "engaged; busy (of a phone line)".

tā de diànhuà yìzhí zhànxiàn — His line has been engaged the whole time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhànxiàn is built from *zhàn* 'to take up' and *xiàn* 'a line'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'thread'; the dictionary lists the first only with another sense, so how it came to mean taking up is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhànxiàn*
- *Say it: zhànxiàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā de diànhuà yìzhí zhànxiàn* — His line has been engaged the whole time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn a phone on, then the Mandarin for to leave a message, then say *zhànxiàn* again

Before you move on

What does zhànxiàn mean? ("Engaged; busy (of a phone line)".) Say it once more.

198.6 xìnhào — phone signal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leave a message, then the Mandarin for engaged (of a phone line).

You'll want to know: xìnhào

xìnhào — "phone signal".

zhèr méiyǒu xìnhào — There's no signal here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìnhào is built from *xìn* 'a sign, a message' and 号 'a call, a mark', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sinH* and *hawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'true' and 'proof', and the second 'to call'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìnhào*
- *Say it: xìnhào*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr méiyǒu xìnhào* — There's no signal here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leave a message, then the Mandarin for engaged (of a phone line), then say *xìnhào* again

Before you move on

What does xìnhào mean? ("Phone signal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 199

Sizes

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what size someone wears, say clothes are thin, baggy or tight, and pick one out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 199: I can ask what size someone wears, say clothes are thin, baggy or tight, and pick one out.*

199.1 chǐmǎ — clothing size; shoe size

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for engaged (of a phone line), then the Mandarin for phone signal.

You'll want to know: chǐmǎ

chǐmǎ — "clothing size; shoe size".

> *nǐ chuān duōdà de chǐmǎ* — What size do you wear?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: chǐ is said with a rising tone before mǎ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǐmǎ is built from *chǐ*, a measure of length, and *mǎ* 'a number sign', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhek* and *maeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the first as a measure of length and glosses the second as a stone like jade; how the pair came

to mean the size of clothes is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǐmǎ*
- *Say it: chǐmǎ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ chuān duōdà de chǐmǎ* — What size do you wear?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for engaged (of a phone line), then the Mandarin for phone signal, then say *chǐmǎ* again

Before you move on

What does chǐmǎ mean? ("Clothing size; shoe size".) Say it once more.

199.2 báo — thin (of cloth or paper)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for phone signal, then the Mandarin for clothing size.

You'll want to know: báo

báo — "thin (of cloth or paper)".

nǐ de yīfu tài báo le — Your clothes are too thin.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

báo is inherited from Middle Chinese *bak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed by the pair 'thick and thin'. Mandarin has two outcomes of that form: *báo* in everyday speech, and *bó* in bookish words.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: báo*
- *Say it: báo*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de yīfu tài báo le* — Your clothes are too thin.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for phone signal, then the Mandarin for clothing size, then say *báo* again

Before you move on

What does báo mean? ("Thin (of cloth or paper)".) Say it once more.

199.3 féi — loose; baggy (of clothes)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for clothing size, then the Mandarin for thin (of cloth or paper).

You'll want to know: féi

féi — "loose; baggy (of clothes)".

zhè tiáo kùzi yǒudiǎnr féi — These trousers are a bit baggy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

féi is inherited from Middle Chinese *bj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'fat' and 'fleshy'. Its use for loose clothes is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: féi*
- *Say it: féi*, once more
- *Say it: zhè tiáo kùzi yǒudiǎnr féi* — These trousers are a bit baggy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for clothing size, then the Mandarin for thin (of cloth or paper), then say *féi* again

Before you move on

What does féi mean? ("Loose; baggy (of clothes)".) Say it once more.

199.4 jǐn — tight

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for thin (of cloth or paper), then the Mandarin for baggy.

You'll want to know: jǐn

jǐn — "tight".

zhè shuāng xié tài jǐn le — These shoes are too tight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǐn is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjinX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'tightly bound'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐn*
- *Say it: jǐn*, once more

- *Say it: zhè shuāng xié tài jǐn le* — These shoes are too tight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for thin (of cloth or paper), then the Mandarin for baggy, then say *jǐn* again

Before you move on

What does jǐn mean? ("Tight".) Say it once more.

199.5 tiāo — to pick out; to choose

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for baggy, then the Mandarin for tight.

You'll want to know: tiāo

tiāo — "to pick out; to choose".

qǐng bāng wǒ tiāo yí ge chǐmǎ — Could you help me pick out a size, please?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiāo is inherited from Middle Chinese *thew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to stir up'. The sense 'to pick out' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiāo*
- *Say it: tiāo*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng bāng wǒ tiāo yí ge chǐmǎ* — Could you help me pick out a size, please?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for baggy, then the Mandarin for tight, then say *tiāo* again

Before you move on

What does tiāo mean? ("To pick out; to choose".) Say it once more.

199.6 Looking back: from Roads and Crossings to Sizes

Say the Mandarin for a street for traffic and to go on foot.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a street for traffic, to go on foot, zebra crossing, public square, traffic lights
- *Say it:* to put money by, to take out money, credit card, password, bank account
- *Say it:* train or bus ticket, plane ticket, scheduled flight, to take off, to reach a destination
- *Say it:* to ask the way, to find, to lose your way, straight on, route
- *Say it:* to switch off, to turn a phone on, to leave a message, engaged (of a phone line), phone signal
- *Say it:* clothing size, thin (of cloth or paper), baggy, tight, to pick out
- *Read it:* 路 票 找 关 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A street for traffic? (马路, *mǎlù.*) To go on foot? (*zǒulù.*) Zebra crossing? (*bānmǎxiàn.*) Public square? (*guǎngchǎng.*) Traffic lights? (*hónglǜdēng.*) To put money by? (*cúnqián.*) To take out money? (*qǔqián.*) Credit card? (*xìnyòngkǎ.*) Password? (*mìmǎ.*) Bank account? (*zhànghù.*) Train or bus ticket? (车票, *chēpiào.*) Plane ticket? (机票, *jīpiào.*) Scheduled flight? (*hángbān.*) To take off? (*qǐfēi.*) To reach a destination? (*dàodá.*) To ask the way? (问路, *wènlù.*) To find? (找到, *zhǎodào.*) To lose your way? (*mílù.*) Straight on? (*yìzhí.*) Route? (*lùxiàn.*) To switch off? (关机, *guānjī.*) To turn a phone on? (开机, *kāijī.*) To leave a message? (*liúyán.*)

Engaged (of a phone line)? (*zhànxiàn.*) Phone signal? (*xìnhào.*) Clothing size? (*chǐmǎ.*) Thin (of cloth or paper)? (*báo.*) Baggy? (*féi.*) Tight? (*jǐn.*) To pick out? (*tiāo.*)

Chapter 200

Booking a Room

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can book a hotel room, ask for a single room, and say when I will check in and check out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 200: I can book a hotel room, ask for a single room, and say when I will check in and check out.*

200.1 bīnguǎn — hotel

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tight, then the Mandarin for to pick out.

You'll want to know: bīnguǎn

bīnguǎn — "hotel".

> *wǒmen de bīnguǎn hěn gānjìng* — Our hotel is very clean.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bīnguǎn is built from *bīn* 'a guest' and *guǎn* 'a lodging', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjin* and *kwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to welcome' and the second as a lodging house.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīnguǎn*
- *Say it: bīnguǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de bīnguǎn hěn gānjìng* — Our hotel is very clean.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tight, then the Mandarin for to pick out, then say *bīnguǎn* again

Before you move on

What does bīnguǎn mean? ("Hotel".) Say it once more.

200.2 yùdìng — to book ahead

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pick out, then the Mandarin for hotel.

You'll want to know: yùdìng

yùdìng — "to book ahead".

wǒ xiǎng yùdìng yí ge fángjiān — I'd like to book a room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùdìng is built from *yù* 'beforehand' and *dìng* 'to order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yoH* and *dengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'before'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùdìng*
- *Say it: yùdìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng yùdìng yí ge fángjiān* — I'd like to book a room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pick out, then the Mandarin for hotel, then say *yùdìng* again

Before you move on

What does yùdìng mean? ("To book ahead".) Say it once more.

200.3 dānrénjiān — single room

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hotel, then the Mandarin for to book ahead.

You'll want to know: dānrénjiān

dānrénjiān — "single room".

wǒ yào yí ge dānrénjiān — I'd like a single room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dānrénjiān is built from *dān* 'single', 人 'person' and 间 'a room'. The first two are inherited from Middle Chinese, *tan* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: dānrénjiān*
- *Say it: dānrénjiān*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ yào yí ge dānrénjiān* — I'd like a single room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hotel, then the Mandarin for to book ahead, then say *dānrénjiān* again

Before you move on

What does dānrénjiān mean? ("Single room".) Say it once more.

200.4 rùzhù — to check in (at a hotel)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to book ahead, then the Mandarin for single room.

You'll want to know: rùzhù

rùzhù — "to check in (at a hotel)".

wǒmen xiàwǔ liǎng diǎn kěyǐ rùzhù — We can check in at two in the afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rùzhù is built from *rù* 'to enter' and *zhù* 'to stay', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyip* and *drjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'within' and the second 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: rùzhù*
- *Say it: rùzhù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiàwǔ liǎng diǎn kěyǐ rùzhù* — We can check in at two in the afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to book ahead, then the Mandarin for single room, then say *rùzhù* again

Before you move on

What does rùzhù mean? ("To check in (at a hotel)".) Say it once more.

200.5 tuìfáng — to check out (of a hotel)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for single room, then the Mandarin for to check in.

You'll want to know: tuìfáng

tuìfáng — "to check out (of a hotel)".

míngtiān jǐ diǎn tuìfáng — What time is check-out tomorrow?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuìfáng is built from *tuì* 'to give back' and 房 'room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwojH* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to draw back'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuìfáng*
- *Say it: tuìfáng*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān jǐ diǎn tuìfáng* — What time is check-out tomorrow?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for single room, then the Mandarin for to check in, then say *tuìfáng* again

Before you move on

What does tuìfáng mean? (“To check out (of a hotel)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 201

Post and Parcels

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can buy stamps, send things by courier, send an email and say I have got it.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 201: I can buy stamps, send things by courier, send an email and say I have got it.*

201.1 yóupiào — postage stamp

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to check in, then the Mandarin for to check out.

You'll want to know: yóupiào

yóupiào — "postage stamp".

> *wǒ yào mǎi liǎng zhāng yóupiào* — I'd like two stamps, please.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóupiào is built from *yóu* 'post' and 票 'a slip'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as a lodge at a border; no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóupiào*
- *Say it: yóupiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào mǎi liǎng zhāng yóupiào* — I'd like two stamps, please.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to check in, then the Mandarin for to check out, then say *yóupiào* again

Before you move on

What does yóupiào mean? ("Postage stamp".) Say it once more.

201.2 kuàidì — express delivery; courier

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to check out, then the Mandarin for postage stamp.

You'll want to know: kuàidì

kuàidì — "express delivery; courier".

wǒ yòng kuàidì jì shū — I'm sending the books by courier.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kuàidì is built from 快 'fast' and *dì* 'to pass along', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khwaejH* and *dejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'pleased' and the second 'to take turns'; how the pair came to mean a courier is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuàidì*
- *Say it: kuàidì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yòng kuàidì jì shū* — I'm sending the books by courier.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to check out, then the Mandarin for postage stamp, then say *kuàidì* again

Before you move on

What does kuàidì mean? ("Express delivery; courier".) Say it once more.

201.3 yóujiàn — email; mail

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for postage stamp, then the Mandarin for courier service.

You'll want to know: yóujiàn

yóujiàn — "email; mail".

lǎoshī de yóujiàn hěn zhòngyào — The teacher's email is important.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóujiàn is built from *yóu* 'post' and *jiàn* 'an item', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuw* and *gjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a portion'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóujiàn*
- *Say it: yóujiàn*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī de yóujiàn hěn zhòngyào* — The teacher's email is important.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for postage stamp, then the Mandarin for courier service, then say *yóujiàn* again

Before you move on

What does yóujiàn mean? ("Email; mail".) Say it once more.

201.4 fāsòng — to send electronically; to send a message or an email

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for courier service, then the Mandarin for email.

You'll want to know: fāsòng

fāsòng — "to send electronically; to send a message or an email".

wǒ yǐjīng fāsòngle yóujiàn — I've already sent the email.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāsòng is built from *fā* 'to send out' and *sòng* 'to send off', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *suwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to start' and 'to open out', and the second 'to send away'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāsòng*
- *Say it: fāsòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǐjīng fāsòngle yóujiàn* — I've already sent the email.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for courier service, then the Mandarin for email, then say *fāsòng* again

Before you move on

What does fāsòng mean? ("To send electronically; to send a message or an email".) Say it once more.

201.5 shōudào — to get something sent; to receive

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for email, then the Mandarin for to send electronically.

You'll want to know: shōudào

shōudào — "to get something sent; to receive".

nǐ shōudào wǒ de yóujiàn le ma — Did you get my email?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōudào is built from *shōu* 'to gather in' and 到 'to arrive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): taking in what has arrived.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōudào*
- *Say it: shōudào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shōudào wǒ de yóujiàn le ma* — Did you get my email?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for email, then the Mandarin for to send electronically, then say *shōudào* again

Before you move on

What does shōudào mean? ("To get something sent; to receive".) Say it once more.

Chapter 202

At the Till

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can pay by scanning a code, ask for a receipt, take something back and find the checkout.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 202: I can pay by scanning a code, ask for a receipt, take something back and find the checkout.*

202.1 sǎomǎ — to scan a code (to pay)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to send electronically, then the Mandarin for to get something sent.

You'll want to know: sǎomǎ

sǎomǎ — "to scan a code (to pay)".

> *kěyǐ sǎomǎ ma* — Can I pay by scanning the code?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: sǎo is said with a rising tone before mǎ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sǎomǎ is built from 扫 'to sweep' and *mǎ* 'a code', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sawX* and *maeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The pair is recent, and how sweeping came to mean scanning is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǎomǎ*
- *Say it: sǎomǎ*, once more
- *Say it: kěyǐ sǎomǎ ma* — Can I pay by scanning the code?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to send electronically, then the Mandarin for to get something sent, then say *sǎomǎ* again

Before you move on

What does sǎomǎ mean? ("To scan a code (to pay)".) Say it once more.

202.2 shōujù — receipt

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get something sent, then the Mandarin for to scan a code.

You'll want to know: shōujù

shōujù — "receipt".

wǒ yào yì zhāng shōujù — I need a receipt.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōujù is built from *shōu* 'to receive' and *jù* 'evidence', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw* and *kjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to rely on'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōujù*
- *Say it: shōujù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào yì zhāng shōujù* — I need a receipt.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get something sent, then the Mandarin for to scan a code, then say *shōujù* again

Before you move on

What does shōujù mean? ("Receipt".) Say it once more.

202.3 tuìhuò — to take goods back; to return goods to a shop

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to scan a code, then the Mandarin for receipt.

You'll want to know: tuìhuò

tuìhuò — "to take goods back; to return goods to a shop".

zhège kěyǐ tuìhuò ma — Can I bring this back?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuìhuò is built from *tuì* 'to give back' and *huò* 'goods', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwojH* and *xwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to draw back' and 'wealth'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuìhuò*
- *Say it: tuìhuò*, once more
- *Say it: zhège kěyǐ tuìhuò ma* — Can I bring this back?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to scan a code, then the Mandarin for receipt, then say *tuìhuò* again

Before you move on

What does tuìhuò mean? ("To take goods back; to return goods to a shop".) Say it once more.

202.4 gùkè — customer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for receipt, then the Mandarin for to take goods back.

You'll want to know: gùkè

gùkè — "customer".

zhèr de gùkè dōu hěn niánqīng — The customers here are all young.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gùkè is built from *gù* 'to look round' and *kè* 'a guest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuH* and *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to look back'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: gùkè*
- *Say it: gùkè*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de gùkè dōu hěn niánqīng* — The customers here are all young.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for receipt, then the Mandarin for to take goods back, then say *gùkè* again

Before you move on

What does gùkè mean? ("Customer".) Say it once more.

202.5 shōuyíntái — checkout; till

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take goods back, then the Mandarin for customer.

You'll want to know: shōuyíntái

shōuyíntái — "checkout; till".

shōuyíntái zài ménkǒu — The checkout is by the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōuyíntái is built from *shōu* 'to take in', *yín* 'silver, money' and *tái* 'a counter', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw*, *ngin* and *doj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the last as a raised square platform of earth.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōuyíntái*
- *Say it: shōuyíntái*, once more
- *Say it: shōuyíntái zài ménkǒu* — The checkout is by the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take goods back, then the Mandarin for customer, then say *shōuyíntái* again

Before you move on

What does shōuyíntái mean? ("Checkout; till".) Say it once more.

Chapter 203

Renting a Flat

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about renting a flat: the landlord, the rent, the deposit and the contract.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 203: I can talk about renting a flat: the landlord, the rent, the deposit and the contract.*

203.1 zū — to rent

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for customer, then the Mandarin for checkout.

You'll want to know: zū

zū — "to rent".

> *wǒ xiǎng zū yí ge fángzi* — I want to rent a flat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zū is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to store up' and 'a tax'. Renting is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: zū*
- *Say it: zū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng zū yí ge fángzi* — I want to rent a flat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for customer, then the Mandarin for checkout, then say *zū* again

Before you move on

What does zū mean? ("To rent".) Say it once more.

203.2 房东 (fángdōng) — landlord; landlady

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for checkout, then the Mandarin for to rent.

You'll want to know: 房东

房东 — *fángdōng* — "landlord; landlady".

我的房东人很好 *wǒ de fángdōng rén hěn hǎo* — My landlord is a nice person.

The new character, in pieces: 东 — five strokes: a bar, a stroke that falls to the left and turns right, a vertical that hooks to the left, then a short stroke falling to the left and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

房东 (*fángdōng*) is built from 房 'house, room' and 东 'east', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjang* and *tuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How the pair came to mean the owner who lets a room is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: fángdōng*
- *Say it: fángdōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de fángdōng rén hěn hǎo* — My landlord is a nice person.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for checkout, then the Mandarin for to rent, then say *fángdōng* again

Before you move on

What does 房东 mean? ("Landlord; landlady".) Say it once more.

203.3 东 — a bar, a turn, a hook and two short strokes

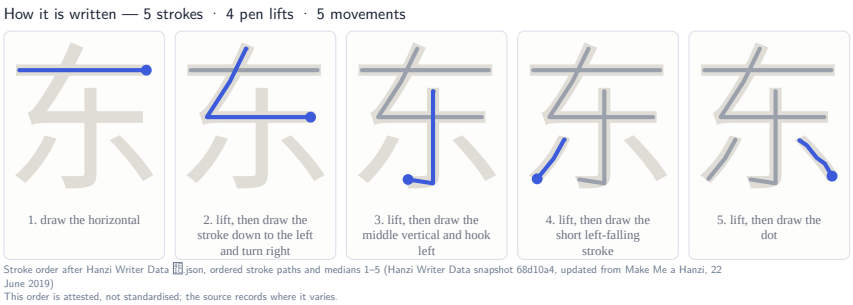
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *fángdōng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  房 车

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *fáng*, *chē*

Script — a bar, a turn, a hook and two short strokes



How 东 *is written, stroke by stroke*

东

One piece, five strokes, top to bottom. Count the strokes in their turns.

First, a bar across the upper middle.

Second, a stroke from above the bar, falling down to the left and turning to run right.

Third, a vertical down the middle, from above the turned stroke and down through it, hooking to the left at its foot.

Last, two short strokes at the foot: one falling to the left, then a dot on the right.

$1 + 1 + 1 + 2 =$ five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 东, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 东? (**Five.**) Which stroke hooks? (**The vertical down the middle.**) What comes last? (**The dot on the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 东, pinned stroke paths and medians.

203.4 fángzū — rent for a home

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to rent, then the Mandarin for landlord.

You'll want to know: fángzū

fángzū — "rent for a home".

zhèr de fángzū tài guì le — The rent here is too high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fángzū is built from 房 'house' and *zū* 'rent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjang* and *tsu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a tax'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: fángzū*
- *Say it: fángzū*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de fángzū tài guì le* — The rent here is too high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to rent, then the Mandarin for landlord, then say *fángzū* again

Before you move on

What does fángzū mean? ("Rent for a home".) Say it once more.

203.5 yājīn — a deposit paid in advance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for landlord, then the Mandarin for rent for a home.

You'll want to know: yājīn

yājīn — "a deposit paid in advance".

> *yājīn shì liǎng ge yuè de fángzū* — The deposit is two months' rent.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yājīn is built from *yā* 'a pledge' and *jīn* 'gold, money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'aep* and *kim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as putting one's mark on a document, so how it came to mean a pledge is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yājīn*
- *Say it: yājīn*, once more
- *Say it: yājīn shì liǎng ge yuè de fángzū* — The deposit is two months' rent.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for landlord, then the Mandarin for rent for a home, then say *yājīn* again

Before you move on

What does yājīn mean? ("A deposit paid in advance".) Say it once more.

203.6 hétong — contract; written agreement

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for rent for a home, then the Mandarin for a deposit paid in advance.

You'll want to know: hétong

hétong — "contract; written agreement".

> *fángdōng de hétong nǐ kànle ma* — Have you read the landlord's contract?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hétong is built from *hé* 'to join' and 同 'together', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hop* and *duwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'alike' and 'together'. The dictionary already pairs the two to gloss the first, in the sense of joining; a written agreement is not given there, so how the word came to it is not settled. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: hétong*
- *Say it: hétong*, once more
- *Say it: fángdōng de hétong nǐ kànle ma* — Have you read the landlord's contract?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for rent for a home, then the Mandarin for a deposit paid in advance, then say *hétong* again

Before you move on

What does hétong mean? ("Contract; written agreement".) Say it once more.

Chapter 204

Online

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about websites, logging in, clicking, videos and typing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 204: I can talk about websites, logging in, clicking, videos and typing.*

204.1 网站 (wǎngzhàn) — website

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a deposit paid in advance, then the Mandarin for contract.

You'll want to know: 网站

网站 — *wǎngzhàn* — "website".

> 这个网站关了 *zhège wǎngzhàn guān le* — This website has closed down.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

网站 (*wǎngzhàn*) is built from 网 'net' and 站 'a station', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjangX* and *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎngzhàn*
- *Say it: wǎngzhàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège wǎngzhàn guān le* — This website has closed down.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a deposit paid in advance, then the Mandarin for contract, then say *wǎngzhàn* again

Before you move on

What does 网站 mean? ("Website".) Say it once more.

204.2 dēnglù — to log in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for contract, then the Mandarin for website.

You'll want to know: dēnglù

dēnglù — "to log in".

nǐ dēnglù le ma — Have you logged in?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēnglù is built from *dēng* 'to go up' and *lù* 'to record', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong* and *ljowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to climb' and the second 'to take down'. Logging in is a modern sense, and how the pair came to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēnglù*
- *Say it: dēnglù*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ dēnglù le ma* — Have you logged in?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for contract, then the Mandarin for website, then say *dēnglù* again

Before you move on

What does dēnglù mean? ("To log in".) Say it once more.

204.3 diǎnjī — to click (on a screen)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for website, then the Mandarin for to log in.

You'll want to know: diǎnjī

diǎnjī — "to click (on a screen)".

qǐng diǎnjī zhèr — Please click here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diǎnjī is built from 点 'a dot, to touch' and *jī* 'to strike', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *temX* and *kek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to hit'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: diǎnjī*
- *Say it: diǎnjī*, once more

- *Say it: qǐng diǎnjī zhèr* — Please click here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for website, then the Mandarin for to log in, then say *diǎnjī* again

Before you move on

What does diǎnjī mean? ("To click (on a screen)".) Say it once more.

204.4 shìpín — video

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to log in, then the Mandarin for to click.

You'll want to know: shìpín

shìpín — "video".

wǒ xǐhuan kàn shìpín — I like watching videos.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shìpín is built from *shì* 'to look at' and *pín* 'frequent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyijH* and *bjin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The word is modern, and how the pair came to mean a video is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìpín*
- *Say it: shìpín*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan kàn shìpín* — I like watching videos.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to log in, then the Mandarin for to click, then say *shìpín* again

Before you move on

What does shìpín mean? (“Video”.) Say it once more.

204.5 打字 (dǎzì) — to type

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to click, then the Mandarin for video.

You’ll want to know: 打字

打字 — *dǎzì* — “to type”.

他打字很快 *tā dǎzì hěn kuài* — He types fast.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

打字 (*dǎzì*) is built from 打 ’to strike’ and 字 ’a character’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *dziH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription): striking out characters. The modern dǎ is not the regular outcome of *taengX*, and how it came is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎzì*
- *Say it: dǎzì*, once more
- *Say it: tā dǎzì hěn kuài* — He types fast.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to click, then the Mandarin for video, then say *dǎzì* again

Before you move on

What does 打字 mean? (“To type”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 205

How Far Is It?

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how far away a place is in kilometres, talk about distance and give a rough figure.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 205: I can say how far away a place is in kilometres, talk about distance and give a rough figure.*

205.1 离 (lí) — from; away from (in distance)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for video, then the Mandarin for to type on a keyboard.

You'll want to know: 离

离 — *lí* — "from; away from (in distance)".

> *wǒ jiā lí xuéxiào hěn jìn* — My home is close to the school.

The new character, in pieces: 离 — ten strokes in three pieces: the dot and the bar that cap 文; two short strokes crossing inside a box open at the top; then a frame that hooks, holding a turning stroke and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

离 (*lí*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *lje* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says that being apart while near is *lí*, and being

apart while far is another word; in another tone it is glossed 'to leave'. Its use for distance from a place is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: lí*
- *Say it: lí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā lí xuéxiào hěn jìn* — My home is close to the school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for video, then the Mandarin for to type on a keyboard, then say *lí* again

Before you move on

What does 离 mean? ("From; away from (in distance)".) Say it once more.

205.2 离 — a cap, a box and a hooked frame

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lí* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  文 开

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wén*, *kāi*

Script — a cap, a box and a hooked frame

How 离 *is written, stroke by stroke*

离

Three pieces, top to bottom.

The top, two strokes: the dot and the bar that cap 文.

The middle, four strokes. A short stroke falling to the left and a dot falling to the right, crossing like a small x. Then a box open at the top round them: a vertical down the left that turns along the foot, and a short vertical on the right.

The bottom, four strokes. A vertical down the left. A bar that turns down the right side and hooks to the left at its foot. Inside, a stroke that falls to the left and turns right, then a dot.

2 + 4 + 4 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 离, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 离? (**Ten.**) What caps it? (**The dot and the bar of 文.**) Which stroke hooks? (**The bar that turns down the right side.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 离, pinned stroke paths and medians.

205.3 公里 (gōnglǐ) — kilometre

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to type on a keyboard, then the Mandarin for away from.

You'll want to know: 公里

公里 — *gōnglǐ* — "kilometre".

书店在东边离这儿两公里 *shūdiàn zài dōngbian lí zhèr liǎng gōnglǐ* — The bookshop is to the east, two kilometres from here.

The new character, in pieces: 公 — four strokes: 八 on top, then a stroke that falls to the left and turns right, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

公里 (*gōnglǐ*) is built from 公 'common, public' and 里 *lǐ*. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'common' and 'without bias'; the dictionary glosses 里 as a neighbourhood of twenty-five households. Its use as a measure of distance, and the pair's use for the kilometre, are not given there, so they are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōnglǐ*
- *Say it: gōnglǐ*, once more

- *Say it: shūdiàn zài dōngbian lí zhèr liǎng gōnglǐ* — The bookshop is to the east, two kilometres from here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to type on a keyboard, then the Mandarin for away from, then say *gōnglǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 公里 mean? (“Kilometre”.) Say it once more.

205.4 公 — 八 over a turn and a dot

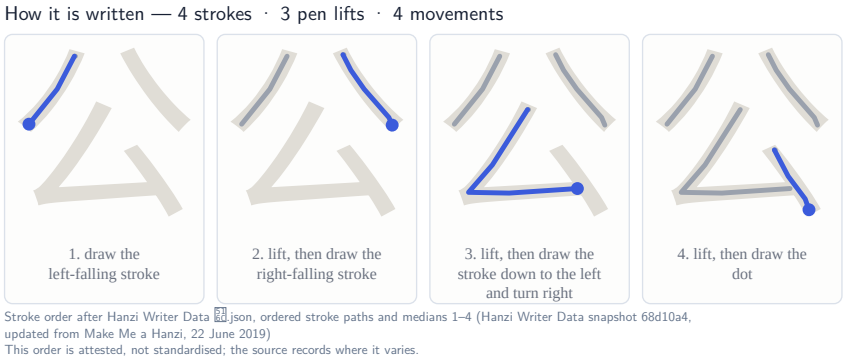
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gōnglǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

八 里

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bā*, *lǐ*

Script — 八 over a turn and a dot



How 公 is written, stroke by stroke

公

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, 八, two strokes: a stroke falling to the left, then a longer one falling to the right, spread wide apart.

The bottom piece, two strokes. A stroke that falls to the left and turns to run right along the foot, then a dot at its right end. The same pair sits in the top left corner of 能.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 公, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 公? (**Four**.) What is the top piece? (八.) Where has your hand made the bottom piece before? (**In the top left of 能.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 公, pinned stroke paths and medians.

205.5 zuǒyòu — about; or so (after a number)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for away from, then the Mandarin for kilometre.

You'll want to know: zuǒyòu

zuǒyòu — "about; or so (after a number)".

zǒulù èrshí fēnzhōng zuǒyòu — It's about twenty minutes on foot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuǒyòu is built from *zuǒ* 'left' and *yòu* 'right', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsaX* and *hjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a little to either side of the number.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuǒyòu*
- *Say it: zuǒyòu*, once more
- *Say it: zǒulù èrshí fēnzhōng zuǒyòu* — It's about twenty minutes on foot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for away from, then the Mandarin for kilometre, then say *zuǒyòu* again

Before you move on

What does zuǒyòu mean? ("About; or so (after a number)".) Say it once more.

205.6 chàbuduō — about; almost

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for kilometre, then the Mandarin for or so.

You'll want to know: chàbuduō

chàbuduō — "about; almost".

cóng zhèr dào chēzhàn chàbuduō liǎng gōnglǐ — From here to the station is almost two kilometres.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
不 loses its tone in the middle of this word: chàbuduō.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chàbuduō is built from *chà* 'short of', 不 'not' and *duō* 'much', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhae*, *pjut* and *ta* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): not much short.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: chàbuduō*
- *Say it: chàbuduō*, once more
- *Say it: cóng zhèr dào chēzhàn chàbuduō liǎng gōnglǐ* — From here to the station is almost two kilometres.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for kilometre, then the Mandarin for or so, then say *chàbuduō* again

Before you move on

What does chàbuduō mean? ("About; almost".) Say it once more.

205.7 jùlí — distance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for or so, then the Mandarin for almost.

You'll want to know: jùlí

jùlí — "distance".

liǎng ge chēzhàn de jùlí shì yì gōnglǐ — The two stations are a kilometre apart.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jùlí is built from *jù* and 离 'away from', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjoX* and *lje* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the spur on a cock's leg; how it came to mean being apart is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: jùlí*
- *Say it: jùlí*, once more
- *Say it: liǎng ge chēzhàn de jùlí shì yì gōnglǐ* — The two stations are a kilometre apart.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for or so, then the Mandarin for almost, then say *jùlí* again

Before you move on

What does jùlí mean? ("Distance".) Say it once more.

205.8 Looking back: from Booking a Room to How Far Is It?

Say the Mandarin for hotel and to book ahead.

Your turn

- *Say it:* hotel, to book ahead, single room, to check in, to check out
- *Say it:* postage stamp, courier service, email, to send electronically, to get something sent
- *Say it:* to scan a code, receipt, to take goods back, customer, checkout
- *Say it:* to rent, landlord, rent for a home, a deposit paid in advance, contract
- *Say it:* website, to log in, to click, video, to type on a keyboard
- *Say it:* away from, kilometre, or so, almost, distance
- *Read it:* 东 离 公 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Hotel? (*bīnguǎn.*) To book ahead? (*yùdìng.*) Single room? (*dānrénjiān.*) To check in? (*rùzhù.*) To check out? (*tuìfáng.*) Postage stamp? (*yóupiào.*) Courier service? (*kuàidì.*) Email? (*yóujiàn.*) To send electronically? (*fāsòng.*) To get something sent? (*shōudào.*) To scan a code? (*sǎomǎ.*) Receipt? (*shōujù.*) To take goods back? (*tuìhuò.*) Customer? (*gùkè.*) Checkout? (*shōuyíntái.*) To rent? (*zū.*) Landlord? (房东, *fángdōng.*) Rent for a home? (*fángzū.*) A deposit paid in advance? (*yājīn.*) Contract? (*hétong.*) Website? (网站, *wǎngzhàn.*) To log in? (*dēnglù.*) To click? (*diǎnjī.*) Video? (*shìpín.*) To type on a keyboard? (打字, *dǎzì.*) Away from? (离, *lí.*) Kilometre? (公里, *gōnglǐ.*) Or so? (*zuǒyòu.*) Almost? (*chàbuduō.*) Distance? (*jùlí.*)

Chapter 206

Upstairs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about buildings and floors, go upstairs, and find the office and the front desk.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 206: I can talk about buildings and floors, go upstairs, and find the office and the front desk.*

206.1 lóu — a building of several floors; a floor

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for almost, then the Mandarin for distance.

You'll want to know: lóu

lóu — "a building of several floors; a floor".

> *wǒ zhù de lóu hěn xīn* — The building I live in is new.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lóu is inherited from Middle Chinese *luw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a house of more than one storey'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: lóu*
- *Say it: lóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhù de lóu hěn xīn* — The building I live in is new.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for almost, then the Mandarin for distance, then say *lóu* again

Before you move on

What does lóu mean? ("A building of several floors; a floor".) Say it once more.

206.2 céng — floor; storey

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for distance, then the Mandarin for a building of several floors.

You'll want to know: céng

céng — "floor; storey".

wǒmen de lóu yǒu èrshí céng — Our building has twenty floors.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

céng is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzong* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed, like the form of *lóu*, 'a house of more than one storey'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: céng*
- *Say it: céng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de lóu yǒu èrshí céng* — Our building has twenty floors.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for distance, then the Mandarin for a building of several floors, then say *céng* again

Before you move on

What does céng mean? ("Floor; storey".) Say it once more.

206.3 shànglóu — to go upstairs

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a building of several floors, then the Mandarin for storey.

You'll want to know: shànglóu

shànglóu — "to go upstairs".

wǒmen zuò diàntī shànglóu — We're taking the lift upstairs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shànglóu is built from 上 'to go up' and *lóu* 'a building of several floors', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *luw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to climb'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: shànglóu*
- *Say it: shànglóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò diàntī shànglóu* — We're taking the lift upstairs.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a building of several floors, then the Mandarin for storey, then say *shànglóu* again

Before you move on

What does shànglóu mean? ("To go upstairs".) Say it once more.

206.4 bàngōngshì — office

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for storey, then the Mandarin for to go upstairs.

You'll want to know: bàngōngshì

bàngōngshì — "office".

lǎoshī zài bàngōngshì — The teacher is in the office.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàngōngshì is built from *bàn* 'to handle', 公 'public' and *shì* 'a room', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *beanH*, *kuwng* and *syit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to provide': a room for public business.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàngōngshì*
- *Say it: bàngōngshì*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī zài bàngōngshì* — The teacher is in the office.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for storey, then the Mandarin for to go upstairs, then say *bàngōngshì* again

Before you move on

What does bàngōngshì mean? ("Office".) Say it once more.

206.5 qiántái — front desk; reception

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go upstairs, then the Mandarin for office.

You'll want to know: qiántái

qiántái — "front desk; reception".

yàoshi zài qiántái — The key is at reception.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiántái is built from 前 'front' and *tái* 'a counter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzen* and *doj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a raised platform.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiántái*
- *Say it: qiántái*, once more

- *Say it: yàoshi zài qiántái* — The key is at reception.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go upstairs, then the Mandarin for office, then say *qiántái* again

Before you move on

What does qiántái mean? (“Front desk; reception”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 207

Where and When

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can agree on a place to meet, talk about plans, arrange things, take photos and visit the sights.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 207: I can agree on a place to meet, talk about plans, arrange things, take photos and visit the sights.*

207.1 地点 (dìdiǎn) — place; venue

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for office, then the Mandarin for reception desk.

You'll want to know: 地点

地点 — *dìdiǎn* — "place; venue".

> 我们见面的地点离这儿两公里 *wǒmen jiànmiàn de dìdiǎn lí zhèr liǎng gōnglǐ* — The place where we're meeting is two kilometres from here.

The new character, in pieces: 地 — six strokes: on the left the earth piece, a short bar, a vertical and a stroke rising to the right, as at the lower right of 在; on the right 也. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

地点 (*dìdiǎn*) is built from 地 'ground, place' and 点 'a point', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the earth'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìdiǎn*
- *Say it: dìdiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiànmiàn de dìdiǎn lí zhèr liǎng gōnglǐ* — The place where we're meeting is two kilometres from here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for office, then the Mandarin for reception desk, then say *dìdiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 地点 mean? ("Place; venue".) Say it once more.

207.2 地 — the earth piece, then 也

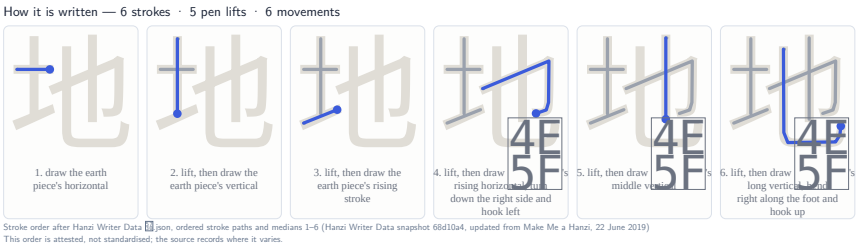
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dìdiǎn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  也 在

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yě*, *zài*

Script — the earth piece, then 也



How 地 *is written, stroke by stroke*

地

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, the earth piece, three strokes. A short bar, a vertical down through it, then a stroke along the foot that rises to the right. It is the piece at the lower right of 在, squeezed to the left.

The right piece, 也, three strokes, the same three as in 也 itself: a bar that turns down and hooks, a short vertical, and a long vertical that bends right along the bottom and hooks up.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 地, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 地? (**Six.**) Which stroke of the left piece rises? (**The last, along the foot.**) What is the right piece? (也.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 地, pinned stroke paths and medians.

207.3 jìhuà — plan

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for reception desk, then the Mandarin for venue.

You'll want to know: jìhuà

jìhuà — "plan".

> *nǐ zhōumò yǒu shénme jìhuà* — What are your plans for the weekend?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìhuà is built from *jì* 'to reckon' and *huà* 'to mark out', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kejH* and *hweak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to count up' and the second 'to cut with an awl'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìhuà*
- *Say it: jìhuà*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zhōumò yǒu shénme jìhuà* — What are your plans for the weekend?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for reception desk, then the Mandarin for venue, then say *jìhuà* again

Before you move on

What does jìhuà mean? ("Plan".) Say it once more.

207.4 ānpái — to arrange

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for venue, then the Mandarin for a plan.

You'll want to know: ānpái

ānpái — "to arrange".

> *māma ānpáile míngtiān de shíjiān* — Mum has planned out tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ānpái is built from *ān* 'to settle' and *pái* 'to set in a row'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *'an* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'calm'; the dictionary glosses the second 'to push aside', so how the pair came to mean arranging is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānpái*
- *Say it: ānpái*, once more
- *Say it: māma ānpáile míngtiān de shíjiān* — Mum has planned out tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for venue, then the Mandarin for a plan, then say *ānpái* again

Before you move on

What does ānpái mean? ("To arrange".) Say it once more.

207.5 zhàoxiàng — to take a photo

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a plan, then the Mandarin for to arrange.

You'll want to know: zhàoxiàng

zhàoxiàng — "to take a photo".

> *zhèr kěyǐ zhàoxiàng ma* — Can I take photos here?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhàoxiàng is built from *zhào* 'to shine on' and *xiàng* 'a likeness', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyewH* and *sjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'bright' and the second 'to look at'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhàoxiàng*
- *Say it: zhàoxiàng*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr kěyǐ zhàoxiàng ma* — Can I take photos here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a plan, then the Mandarin for to arrange, then say *zhàoxiàng* again

Before you move on

What does zhàoxiàng mean? ("To take a photo".) Say it once more.

207.6 jǐngdiǎn — sight; place of interest

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to arrange, then the Mandarin for to take a photo.

You'll want to know: jǐngdiǎn

jǐngdiǎn — "sight; place of interest".

nǐ qùguò zhège jǐngdiǎn ma — Have you been to this sight?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: jǐng is said with a rising tone before diǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǐngdiǎn is built from *jǐng* 'a view' and 点 'a point', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengX* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'bright' and 'great'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐngdiǎn*
- *Say it: jǐngdiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ qùguò zhège jǐngdiǎn ma* — Have you been to this sight?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to arrange, then the Mandarin for to take a photo, then say *jǐngdiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does jǐngdiǎn mean? ("Sight; place of interest".) Say it once more.

Chapter 208

Getting Things Fixed

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can call a repairer, have something checked or put in, and talk about tools and batteries.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 208: I can call a repairer, have something checked or put in, and talk about tools and batteries.*

208.1 shīfu — skilled tradesman; master (and how you address one)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take a photo, then the Mandarin for tourist sight.

You'll want to know: shīfu

shīfu — "skilled tradesman; master (and how you address one)".

> *shīfu wǒ de diànnǎo huài le* — Excuse me, my computer is broken.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīfu is built from *shī* 'a teacher', the *shī* of *lǎoshī*, and *fu* 'a tutor', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srij* and *pjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to assist'. In the

word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīfu*
- *Say it: shīfu*, once more
- *Say it: shīfu wǒ de diànnǎo huài le* — Excuse me, my computer is broken.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take a photo, then the Mandarin for tourist sight, then say *shīfu* again

Before you move on

What does shīfu mean? ("Skilled tradesman; master (and how you address one)".) Say it once more.

208.2 jiǎnchá — to check; to examine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tourist sight, then the Mandarin for skilled tradesman.

You'll want to know: jiǎnchá

jiǎnchá — "to check; to examine".

yīshēng jiǎnchále wǒ de yǎnjing — The doctor examined my eyes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎnchá is built from two words for looking into things, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjemX* and *dzrae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the seal on a

document and 'to check'; it glosses the second as a raft, so how it came to mean examining is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎnchá*
- *Say it: jiǎnchá*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng jiǎnchále wǒ de yǎnjing* — The doctor examined my eyes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tourist sight, then the Mandarin for skilled tradesman, then say *jiǎnchá* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎnchá mean? ("To check; to examine".) Say it once more.

208.3 ānzhuāng — to install; to put in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for skilled tradesman, then the Mandarin for to examine.

You'll want to know: ānzhuāng

ānzhuāng — "to install; to put in".

tāmen zài ānzhuāng diànshì — They're installing the television.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ānzhuāng is built from *ān* 'to settle' and *zhuāng* 'to fit out', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an* and *tsrjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'calm' and the second

'to pack up' and 'to dress'. Putting a machine in place is not given there, so how the pair came to it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānzhuāng*
- *Say it: ānzhuāng*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen zài ānzhuāng diànshì* — They're installing the television.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for skilled tradesman, then the Mandarin for to examine, then say *ānzhuāng* again

Before you move on

What does ānzhuāng mean? ("To install; to put in".) Say it once more.

208.4 gōngjù — tool

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to examine, then the Mandarin for to install.

You'll want to know: gōngjù

gōngjù — "tool".

shīfu dàile gōngjù — The repairman brought his tools.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngjù is built from *gōng* 'work' and *jù* 'an implement', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *gjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to prepare'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngjù*
- *Say it: gōngjù*, once more
- *Say it: shīfu dàile gōngjù* — The repairman brought his tools.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to examine, then the Mandarin for to install, then say *gōngjù* again

Before you move on

What does gōngjù mean? ("Tool".) Say it once more.

208.5 diànchí — battery

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to install, then the Mandarin for tool.

You'll want to know: diànchí

diànchí — "battery".

shǒujī de diànchí huài le — The phone's battery has gone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diànchí is built from 电 'electricity' and *chí* 'a pool', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *drje* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as standing water: a pool of electricity.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: diànchí*
- *Say it: diànchí*, once more
- *Say it: shǒujī de diànchí huài le* — The phone's battery has gone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to install, then the Mandarin for tool, then say *diànchí* again

Before you move on

What does diànchí mean? ("Battery".) Say it once more.

Chapter 209

Rules and Notices

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read the rules on a notice: what is safe, keeping quiet, not disturbing, and what is not allowed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 209: I can read the rules on a notice: what is safe, keeping quiet, not disturbing, and what is not allowed.*

209.1 guīdìng — rule; regulation

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tool, then the Mandarin for battery.

You'll want to know: guīdìng

guīdìng — "rule; regulation".

> *zhè shì xuéxiào de guīdìng* — That's the school's rule.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guīdìng is built from *guī* 'a pair of compasses, a rule' and *dìng* 'to settle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjwie* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'round' and the second 'calm'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: guīdìng*
- *Say it: guīdìng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì xuéxiào de guīdìng* — That's the school's rule.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tool, then the Mandarin for battery, then say *guīdìng* again

Before you move on

What does guīdìng mean? ("Rule; regulation".) Say it once more.

209.2 ānquán — safe; safety

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for battery, then the Mandarin for regulation.

You'll want to know: ānquán

ānquán — "safe; safety".

wǎnshang yí ge rén zǒulù bù ānquán — It isn't safe to walk on your own at night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ānquán is built from *ān* 'calm' and *quán* 'whole', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an* and *dzjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānquán*
- *Say it: ānquán*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang yí ge rén zǒulù bù ānquán* — It isn't safe to walk on your own at night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for battery, then the Mandarin for regulation, then say *ānquán* again

Before you move on

What does ānquán mean? ("Safe; safety".) Say it once more.

209.3 bǎochí — to keep up; to keep as it is

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for regulation, then the Mandarin for safe.

You'll want to know: bǎochí

bǎochí — "to keep up; to keep as it is".

qǐng bǎochí ānjìng — Please keep quiet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎochí is built from *bǎo* 'to guard' and *chí* 'to hold', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *dri* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to keep safe' and the second 'to grasp'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎochí*
- *Say it: bǎochí*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng bǎochí ānjìng* — Please keep quiet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for regulation, then the Mandarin for safe, then say *bǎochí* again

Before you move on

What does bǎochí mean? (“To keep up; to keep as it is”.) Say it once more.

209.4 dǎrǎo — to disturb

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for safe, then the Mandarin for to keep up.

You’ll want to know: dǎrǎo

dǎrǎo — “to disturb”.

qǐng bú yào dǎrǎo wǒ — Please don’t disturb me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: dǎ is said with a rising tone before rǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎrǎo is built from 扌丁 ’to strike’ and *rǎo* ’to trouble’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *nyewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the second ’to throw into disorder’ and ’to vex’.

What you’ve built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎrǎo*
- *Say it: dǎrǎo*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng bú yào dǎrǎo wǒ* — Please don't disturb me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for safe, then the Mandarin for to keep up, then say *dǎrǎo* again

Before you move on

What does dǎrǎo mean? ("To disturb".) Say it once more.

209.5 yǔnxǔ — to allow; to permit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep up, then the Mandarin for to disturb.

You'll want to know: yǔnxǔ

yǔnxǔ — "to allow; to permit".

zhèr bù yǔnxǔ xīyān — Smoking isn't allowed here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: yǔn is said with a rising tone before xǔ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǔnxǔ is built from *yǔn* and *xǔ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ywinX* and *xjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'true' and the second 'to permit'.

What you've built

One more word for reading notices and messages.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǔnxǔ*
- *Say it: yǔnxǔ*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr bù yǔnxǔ xīyān* — Smoking isn't allowed here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep up, then the Mandarin for to disturb, then say *yǔnxǔ* again

Before you move on

What does yǔnxǔ mean? ("To allow; to permit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 210

Colours and Styles

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name purple and brown, talk about styles, choose one and find the fitting room.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 210: I can name purple and brown, talk about styles, choose one and find the fitting room.*

210.1 zǐsè — purple

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to disturb, then the Mandarin for to permit.

You'll want to know: zǐsè

zǐsè — "purple".

> *wǒ xǐhuan zǐsè* — I like purple.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zǐsè is built from *zǐ* 'purple' and *sè* 'colour', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjeX* and *srik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a colour between the pure ones.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǐsè*
- *Say it: zǐsè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan zǐsè* — I like purple.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to disturb, then the Mandarin for to permit, then say *zǐsè* again

Before you move on

What does zǐsè mean? ("Purple".) Say it once more.

210.2 zōngsè — brown

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to permit, then the Mandarin for purple.

You'll want to know: zōngsè

zōngsè — "brown".

wǒ yào zōngsè de — I'll have the brown one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zōngsè is built from *zōng* and *sè* 'colour'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *srik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: zōngsè*
- *Say it: zōngsè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào zōngsè de* — I'll have the brown one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to permit, then the Mandarin for purple, then say *zōngsè* again

Before you move on

What does zōngsè mean? ("Brown".) Say it once more.

210.3 kuǎnshì — style; design

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for purple, then the Mandarin for brown.

You'll want to know: kuǎnshì

kuǎnshì — "style; design".

zhège kuǎnshì hěn hǎokàn — This style looks nice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kuǎnshì is built from *kuǎn* and *shì* 'a model', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khwanX* and *syik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'sincere' and the second 'a rule'; how the pair came to mean a style is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuǎnshì*
- *Say it: kuǎnshì*, once more
- *Say it: zhège kuǎnshì hěn hǎokàn* — This style looks nice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for purple, then the Mandarin for brown, then say *kuǎnshì* again

Before you move on

What does kuǎnshì mean? ("Style; design".) Say it once more.

210.4 试衣间 (shìyījiān) — fitting room

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for brown, then the Mandarin for style of clothes.

You'll want to know: 试衣间

试衣间 — *shìyījiān* — "fitting room".

我在找试衣间 *wǒ zài zhǎo shìyījiān* — I'm looking for the fitting room.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

试衣间 (*shìyījiān*) is built from 试 'to try', 衣 'clothes' and 间 'a room'. The first two are inherited from Middle Chinese, *syiH* and *'j+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìyījiān*
- *Say it: shìyījiān*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ zài zhǎo shìyīfjiān* — I'm looking for the fitting room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for brown, then the Mandarin for style of clothes, then say *shìyīfjiān* again

Before you move on

What does 试衣间 mean? ("Fitting room".) Say it once more.

210.5 xuǎn — to choose

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for style of clothes, then the Mandarin for fitting room.

You'll want to know: xuǎn

xuǎn — "to choose".

nǐ xuǎn nǎge yánsè — Which colour are you choosing?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuǎn is inherited from Middle Chinese *sjwenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to choose'.

What you've built

One more word for asking for what I want.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuǎn*
- *Say it: xuǎn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xuǎn nǎge yánsè* — Which colour are you choosing?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for style of clothes, then the Mandarin for fitting room, then say *xuǎn* again

Before you move on

What does xuǎn mean? (“To choose”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 211

Local or From Out of Town

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who is local and who comes from elsewhere, and talk about the city centre and a map.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 211: I can say who is local and who comes from elsewhere, and talk about the city centre and a map.*

211.1 本地 (běndì) — local

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fitting room, then the Mandarin for to choose.

You'll want to know: 本地

本地 — *běndì* — "local".

> 我们找一个本地人问路 *wǒmen zhǎo yí ge běndì rén wènlù* — Let's find someone local and ask the way.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

本地 (*běndì*) is built from 本 'root, one's own' and 地 'place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwonX* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the root of a tree and 'the beginning'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: běndì*
- *Say it: běndì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhǎo yí ge běndì rén wènlù* — Let's find someone local and ask the way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fitting room, then the Mandarin for to choose, then say *běndì* again

Before you move on

What does 本地 mean? ("Local".) Say it once more.

211.2 外地 (wàidì) — from out of town; another part of the country

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to choose, then the Mandarin for local.

You'll want to know: 外地

外地 — *wàidì* — "from out of town; another part of the country".

他是外地人每天开车一百公里 *tā shì wàidì rén měitiān kāichē yìbǎi gōnglǐ* — He's from out of town and drives a hundred kilometres every day.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

外地 (*wàidì*) is built from 外 'outside' and 地 'place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàidì*
- *Say it: wàidì*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wàidì rén měitiān kāichē yìbǎi gōnglǐ* — He's from out of town and drives a hundred kilometres every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to choose, then the Mandarin for local, then say *wàidì* again

Before you move on

What does 外地 mean? ("From out of town; another part of the country".) Say it once more.

211.3 shìzhōngxīn — city centre

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for local, then the Mandarin for from out of town.

You'll want to know: shìzhōngxīn

shìzhōngxīn — "city centre".

wǒ jiā zài shìzhōngxīn — My home is in the city centre.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shìzhōngxīn is built from *shì* 'a market, a city', 中 'middle' and 心 'heart', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyiX*, *trjuwng* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the place where buying and selling is done.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìzhōngxīn*
- *Say it: shìzhōngxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā zài shìzhōngxīn* — My home is in the city centre.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for local, then the Mandarin for from out of town, then say *shìzhōngxīn* again

Before you move on

What does shìzhōngxīn mean? ("City centre".) Say it once more.

211.4 dìtú — map

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for from out of town, then the Mandarin for city centre.

You'll want to know: dìtú

dìtú — "map".

nǐ yǒu Běijīng de dìtú ma — Have you got a map of Beijing?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìtú is built from 地 'ground' and *tú* 'a plan, a chart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *du* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to plan'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìtú*
- *Say it: dìtú*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu Běijīng de dìtú ma* — Have you got a map of Beijing?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for from out of town, then the Mandarin for city centre, then say *dìtú* again

Before you move on

What does dìtú mean? ("Map".) Say it once more.

211.5 dàochù — everywhere

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for city centre, then the Mandarin for map.

You'll want to know: dàochù

dàochù — "everywhere".

shìzhōngxīn dàochù dōu shì rén — There are people everywhere in the city centre.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàochù is built from 到 'to reach' and *chù* 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tawH* and *tsyhoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a place'.

What you've built

One more word for asking where things are.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàochù*
- *Say it: dàochù*, once more
- *Say it: shìzhōngxīn dàochù dōu shì rén* — There are people everywhere in the city centre.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for city centre, then the Mandarin for map, then say *dàochù* again

Before you move on

What does dàochù mean? ("Everywhere".) Say it once more.

211.6 Looking back: from Upstairs to Local or From Out of Town

Say the Mandarin for a building of several floors and storey.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a building of several floors, storey, to go upstairs, office, reception desk
- *Say it:* venue, a plan, to arrange, to take a photo, tourist sight
- *Say it:* skilled tradesman, to examine, to install, tool, battery
- *Say it:* regulation, safe, to keep up, to disturb, to permit
- *Say it:* purple, brown, style of clothes, fitting room, to choose
- *Say it:* local, from out of town, city centre, map, everywhere
- *Read it:* 地 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A building of several floors? (*lóu.*) Storey? (*céng.*) To go upstairs? (*shànglóu.*) Office? (*bàngōngshì.*) Reception desk? (*qiántái.*) Venue? (地点, *dìdiǎn.*) A plan? (*jìhuà.*) To arrange? (*ānpái.*) To take a

photo? (*zhàoxiàng.*) Tourist sight? (*jǐngdiǎn.*) Skilled tradesman? (*shīfu.*) To examine? (*jiǎnchá.*) To install? (*ānzhuāng.*) Tool? (*gōngjù.*) Battery? (*diànchí.*) Regulation? (*guīdìng.*) Safe? (*ānquán.*) To keep up? (*bǎochí.*) To disturb? (*dǎrǎo.*) To permit? (*yǔnxǔ.*) Purple? (*zǐsè.*) Brown? (*zōngsè.*) Style of clothes? (*kuǎnshì.*) Fitting room? (试衣间, *shìyījiān.*) To choose? (*xuǎn.*) Local? (本地, *běndì.*) From out of town? (外地, *wàidì.*) City centre? (*shìzhōngxīn.*) Map? (*dìtú.*) Everywhere? (*dàochù.*)

Chapter 212

Services in Town

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can print and photocopy things, top up my phone, make an appointment and get a haircut.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 212: I can print and photocopy things, top up my phone, make an appointment and get a haircut.*

212.1 dǎyìn — to print out

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for map, then the Mandarin for everywhere.

You'll want to know: dǎyìn

dǎyìn — "to print out".

> *wǒ xiǎng dǎyìn liǎng zhāng zhàopiàn* — I'd like to print two photos.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎyìn is built from 扌丁 'to strike' and *yìn* 'a seal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *'jinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a seal of office.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎyìn*
- *Say it: dǎyìn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng dǎyìn liǎng zhāng zhàopiàn* — I'd like to print two photos.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for map, then the Mandarin for everywhere, then say *dǎyìn* again

Before you move on

What does dǎyìn mean? ("To print out".) Say it once more.

212.2 fùyìn — to photocopy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for everywhere, then the Mandarin for to print out.

You'll want to know: fùyìn

fùyìn — "to photocopy".

qǐng bāng wǒ fùyìn shēnfènzhèng — Could you copy my identity card for me, please?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fùyìn is built from *fù* 'double' and *yìn* 'a seal, a print', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwk* and *'jinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a lined garment.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùyìn*
- *Say it: fùyìn*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng bāng wǒ fùyìn shēnfènzhèng* — Could you copy my identity card for me, please?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for everywhere, then the Mandarin for to print out, then say *fùyìn* again

Before you move on

What does fùyìn mean? ("To photocopy".) Say it once more.

212.3 chōngzhí — to top up (a card or a phone)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to print out, then the Mandarin for to photocopy.

You'll want to know: chōngzhí

chōngzhí — "to top up (a card or a phone)".

nǐ de shǒujī chōngzhí le ma — Have you topped up your phone?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chōngzhí is built from *chōng* 'to fill' and *zhí* 'a value', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhuwng* and *driH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'full' and the second 'to hold' and 'to match'. The dictionary gives the second a departing tone, so the rising tone of zhí is not the regular outcome, and how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: chōngzhí*
- *Say it: chōngzhí*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de shǒujī chōngzhí le ma* — Have you topped up your phone?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to print out, then the Mandarin for to photocopy, then say *chōngzhí* again

Before you move on

What does chōngzhí mean? ("To top up (a card or a phone)".) Say it once more.

212.4 yùyuē — to make an appointment; to book

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to photocopy, then the Mandarin for to top up.

You'll want to know: yùyuē

yùyuē — "to make an appointment; to book".

kěyǐ yùyuē ma — Can I make an appointment?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùyuē is built from *yù* 'beforehand' and *yuē* 'to bind, to agree', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yoH* and *'jak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'before' and the second 'to tie up'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùyuē*
- *Say it: yùyuē*, once more
- *Say it: kěyǐ yùyuē ma* — Can I make an appointment?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to photocopy, then the Mandarin for to top up, then say *yùyuē* again

Before you move on

What does yùyuē mean? ("To make an appointment; to book".) Say it once more.

212.5 lǐfà — to get a haircut

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to top up, then the Mandarin for to make an appointment.

You'll want to know: lǐfà

lǐfà — "to get a haircut".

wǒ yùyuēle míngtiān qù lǐfà — I've booked to get my hair cut tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǐfà is built from *lǐ* 'to put in order' and *fà* 'the hair of the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *liX* and *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to work jade'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐfà*
- *Say it: lǐfà*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yùyuēle míngtiān qù lǐfà* — I've booked to get my hair cut tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to top up, then the Mandarin for to make an appointment, then say *lǐfà* again

Before you move on

What does lǐfà mean? ("To get a haircut".) Say it once more.

Chapter 213

A Trip Abroad

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about visas, tour guides, tourists and tickets, and wish someone a safe journey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 213: I can talk about visas, tour guides, tourists and tickets, and wish someone a safe journey.*

213.1 qiānzhèng — visa

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make an appointment, then the Mandarin for to get a haircut.

You'll want to know: qiānzhèng

qiānzhèng — "visa".

> *wǒ hái méiyǒu qiānzhèng* — I haven't got a visa yet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiānzhèng is built from *qiān* 'to sign' and *zhèng* 'proof'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to verify'; no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiānzhèng*
- *Say it: qiānzhèng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hái méiyǒu qiānzhèng* — I haven't got a visa yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make an appointment, then the Mandarin for to get a haircut, then say *qiānzhèng* again

Before you move on

What does qiānzhèng mean? ("Visa".) Say it once more.

213.2 dǎoyóu — tour guide

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get a haircut, then the Mandarin for visa.

You'll want to know: dǎoyóu

dǎoyóu — "tour guide".

wǒmen de dǎoyóu shì běndì rén — Our tour guide is a local.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎoyóu is built from *dǎo* 'to lead' and *yóu* 'to travel about', the *yóu* of *lǚyóu*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dawH* and *yuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to lead'. The dictionary gives it a departing tone, so the rising tone of dǎo is not the regular outcome, and how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎoyóu*
- *Say it: dǎoyóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de dǎoyóu shì běndì rén* — Our tour guide is a local.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get a haircut, then the Mandarin for visa, then say *dǎoyóu* again

Before you move on

What does dǎoyóu mean? ("Tour guide".) Say it once more.

213.3 yóukè — tourist

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for visa, then the Mandarin for tour guide.

You'll want to know: yóukè

yóukè — "tourist".

zhèr de yóukè dōu shì wàiguó rén — The tourists here are all from abroad.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóukè is built from *yóu* 'to travel about' and *kè* 'a guest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóukè*
- *Say it: yóukè*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de yóukè dōu shì wàiguó rén* — The tourists here are all from abroad.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for visa, then the Mandarin for tour guide, then say *yóukè* again

Before you move on

What does yóukè mean? ("Tourist".) Say it once more.

213.4 门票 (ménpiào) — admission ticket

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tour guide, then the Mandarin for tourist.

You'll want to know: 门票

门票 — *ménpiào* — "admission ticket".

门票多少钱 *ménpiào duōshao qián* — How much is it to get in?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

门票 (*ménpiào*) is built from 门 'gate' and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: ménpiào*
- *Say it: ménpiào*, once more

- *Say it: ménpiào duōshao qián* — How much is it to get in?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tour guide, then the Mandarin for tourist, then say *ménpiào* again

Before you move on

What does 门票 mean? ("Admission ticket".) Say it once more.

213.5 yílù píng'ān — have a safe journey

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tourist, then the Mandarin for admission ticket.

You'll want to know: yílù píng'ān

yílù píng'ān — "have a safe journey".

nǐ míngtiān huíguó yílù píng'ān — You're going home tomorrow: have a safe journey!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
一 changes its tone here: yí, before the falling tone of lù.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yílù píng'ān is built from 一路 'the whole way' and *píng'ān* 'safe and sound', all four parts inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit*, *luH*, *bjaeng* and *'an* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yílù píng'ān*
- *Say it: yílù píng'ān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ míngtiān huíguó yílù píng'ān* — You're going home tomorrow: have a safe journey!

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tourist, then the Mandarin for admission ticket, then say *yílù píng'ān* again

Before you move on

What does yílù píng'ān mean? ("Have a safe journey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 214

Asking for Help

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I have a question, ask someone to tell me, say I understand, and ask what to do.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 214: I can say I have a question, ask someone to tell me, say I understand, and ask what to do.*

214.1 wèntí — question; problem

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for admission ticket, then the Mandarin for have a safe journey.

You'll want to know: wèntí

wèntí — "question; problem".

> *wǒ yǒu yí ge wèntí* — I've got a question.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wèntí is built from 问 'to ask' and *tí* 'a heading', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjunH* and *dej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the forehead' and 'the title of a book'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: wèntí*
- *Say it: wèntí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒu yí ge wèntí* — I've got a question.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for admission ticket, then the Mandarin for have a safe journey, then say *wèntí* again

Before you move on

What does wèntí mean? ("Question; problem".) Say it once more.

214.2 gàosu — to tell

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for have a safe journey, then the Mandarin for problem.

You'll want to know: gàosu

gàosu — "to tell".

qǐng gàosu wǒ nǐ de hàomǎ — Please tell me your number.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gàosu is built from *gào* 'to report' and *su* 'to tell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kawH* and *suH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: gàosu*
- *Say it: gàosu*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng gàosu wǒ nǐ de hàomǎ* — Please tell me your number.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for have a safe journey, then the Mandarin for problem, then say *gàosu* again

Before you move on

What does gàosu mean? ("To tell".) Say it once more.

214.3 明白 (míngbai) — to grasp a meaning; to understand; clear

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for problem, then the Mandarin for to tell someone.

You'll want to know: 明白

明白 — *míngbai* — "to grasp a meaning; to understand; clear".

我明白你很关心我 *wǒ míngbai nǐ hěn guānxīn wǒ* — I know how much you care about me.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

明白 (*míngbai*) is built from 明 'bright' and 白 'white', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjaeng* and *baek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): bright and clear. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngbai*

- *Say it: míngbai*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ míngbai nǐ hěn guānxīn wǒ* — I know how much you care about me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for problem, then the Mandarin for to tell someone, then say *míngbai* again

Before you move on

What does 明白 mean? ("To grasp a meaning; to understand; clear".) Say it once more.

214.4 bànfǎ — a way to deal with it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to tell someone, then the Mandarin for to grasp a meaning.

You'll want to know: bànfǎ

bànfǎ — "a way to deal with it".

wǒ méiyǒu bànfǎ — There's nothing I can do.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bànfǎ is built from *bàn* 'to handle' and *fǎ* 'a method', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *beanH* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to provide' and the second 'a rule'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: bànfǎ*
- *Say it: bànfǎ*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ méiyǒu bànfǎ* — There's nothing I can do.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to tell someone, then the Mandarin for to grasp a meaning, then say *bànfǎ* again

Before you move on

What does bànfǎ mean? ("A way to deal with it".) Say it once more.

214.5 zěnme bàn — what should I do?

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to grasp a meaning, then the Mandarin for a way to deal with it.

You'll want to know: zěnme bàn

zěnme bàn — "what should I do?".

wǒ de hùzhào diū le zěnme bàn — I've lost my passport. What should I do?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zěnme bàn is built from *zěnme* 'how' and *bàn* 'to handle'. The last is inherited from Middle Chinese *beanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of *zěn*, so the history of *zěnme* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: zěnme bàn*
- *Say it: zěnme bàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de hùzhào diū le zěnme bàn* — I've lost my passport. What should I do?

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to grasp a meaning, then the Mandarin for a way to deal with it, then say *zěnme bàn* again

Before you move on

What does zěnme bàn mean? (“What should I do?”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 215

Deliveries and the Laundry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can have goods delivered, sign for a parcel, leave luggage in safekeeping and use the laundry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 215: I can have goods delivered, sign for a parcel, leave luggage in safekeeping and use the laundry.*

215.1 sònghuò — to deliver goods

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a way to deal with it, then the Mandarin for what should I do.

You'll want to know: sònghuò

sònghuò — "to deliver goods".

> *tāmen míngtiān sònghuò* — They're delivering tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sònghuò is built from *sòng* 'to send' and *huò* 'goods', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *suwngH* and *xwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to send off'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: sònghuò*
- *Say it: sònghuò*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen míngtiān sònghuò* — They're delivering tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a way to deal with it, then the Mandarin for what should I do, then say *sònghuò* again

Before you move on

What does sònghuò mean? ("To deliver goods".) Say it once more.

215.2 qiānshōu — to sign for (a delivery)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what should I do, then the Mandarin for to deliver goods.

You'll want to know: qiānshōu

qiānshōu — "to sign for (a delivery)".

kuàidì dào le qǐng qiānshōu — Your delivery is here; please sign for it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiānshōu is built from *qiān* 'to sign' and *shōu* 'to receive'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *syuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiānshōu*
- *Say it: qiānshōu*, once more
- *Say it: kuàidì dào le qǐng qiānshōu* — Your delivery is here; please sign for it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what should I do, then the Mandarin for to deliver goods, then say *qiānshōu* again

Before you move on

What does qiānshōu mean? ("To sign for (a delivery)".) Say it once more.

215.3 jìcún — to leave in safekeeping

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to deliver goods, then the Mandarin for to sign for.

You'll want to know: jìcún

jìcún — "to leave in safekeeping".

xíngli kěyǐ jìcún ma — Can I leave my luggage here?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìcún is built from *jì* 'to entrust' and *cún* 'to keep', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjeH* and *dzwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to entrust'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìcún*
- *Say it: jìcún*, once more
- *Say it: xíngli kěyǐ jìcún ma* — Can I leave my luggage here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to deliver goods, then the Mandarin for to sign for, then say *jìcún* again

Before you move on

What does jìcún mean? ("To leave in safekeeping".) Say it once more.

215.4 洗衣店 (xǐyīdiàn) — laundry shop

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sign for, then the Mandarin for to leave in safekeeping.

You'll want to know: 洗衣店

洗衣店 — *xǐyīdiàn* — "laundry shop".

洗衣店在书店东边 *xǐyīdiàn zài shūdiàn dōngbian* — The laundry is to the east of the bookshop.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

洗衣店 (*xǐyīdiàn*) is built from 洗 'to wash', 衣 'clothes' and 店 'a shop', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejX*, *'j+j* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐyīdiàn*
- *Say it: xǐyīdiàn*, once more

- *Say it: xǐyīdiàn zài shūdiàn dōngbian* — The laundry is to the east of the bookshop.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sign for, then the Mandarin for to leave in safekeeping, then say *xǐyīdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 洗衣店 mean? ("Laundry shop".) Say it once more.

215.5 gānxǐ — to dry-clean

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leave in safekeeping, then the Mandarin for laundry shop.

You'll want to know: gānxǐ

gānxǐ — "to dry-clean".

zhège kěyǐ gānxǐ ma — Can this be dry-cleaned?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gānxǐ is built from *gān* 'dry' and 洗 'to wash', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kan* and *sejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for everyday actions.

Your turn

- *Say it: gānxǐ*
- *Say it: gānxǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhège kěyǐ gānxǐ ma* — Can this be dry-cleaned?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leave in safekeeping, then the Mandarin for laundry shop, then say *gānxǐ* again

Before you move on

What does gānxǐ mean? (“To dry-clean”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 216

Something Has Gone Wrong

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say something has gone wrong or is strange, that someone has stolen something, and call the police.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 216: I can say something has gone wrong or is strange, that someone has stolen something, and call the police.*

216.1 zāogāo — oh no; what a mess

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for laundry shop, then the Mandarin for to dry-clean.

You'll want to know: zāogāo

zāogāo — "oh no; what a mess".

> *zāogāo wǒ de qiánbāo diū le* — Oh no, I've lost my wallet!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zāogāo is built from *zāo* 'dregs' and *gāo* 'cake', both inherited from Middle Chinese (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): *tsaw*, glossed 'dregs', and probably the *kaw* that the dictionary writes with another form of the character, glossed with a word for gruel. How the pair came to mean a mess is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: zāogāo*
- *Say it: zāogāo*, once more
- *Say it: zāogāo wǒ de qiánbāo diū le* — Oh no, I've lost my wallet!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for laundry shop, then the Mandarin for to dry-clean, then say *zāogāo* again

Before you move on

What does zāogāo mean? ("Oh no; what a mess".) Say it once more.

216.2 qíguài — strange; odd

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dry-clean, then the Mandarin for oh no.

You'll want to know: qíguài

qíguài — "strange; odd".

zhège rén hěn qíguài — That person is strange.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qíguài is built from *qí* and *guài*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gje* and *kweajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'different' and the second 'strange'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: qíguài*
- *Say it: qíguài*, once more
- *Say it: zhège rén hěn qíguài* — That person is strange.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dry-clean, then the Mandarin for oh no, then say *qíguài* again

Before you move on

What does qíguài mean? ("Strange; odd".) Say it once more.

216.3 tōu — to steal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for oh no, then the Mandarin for odd.

You'll want to know: tōu

tōu — "to steal".

yǒu rén tōule wǒ de zìxíngchē — Somebody has stolen my bike.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tōu is inherited from Middle Chinese *thuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to rob'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōu*
- *Say it: tōu*, once more

- *Say it: yǒu rén tōule wǒ de zìxíngchē* — Somebody has stolen my bike.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for oh no, then the Mandarin for odd, then say *tōu* again

Before you move on

What does tōu mean? ("To steal".) Say it once more.

216.4 jǐngchá — police officer; the police

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for odd, then the Mandarin for to steal.

You'll want to know: jǐngchá

jǐngchá — "police officer; the police".

jǐngchá lái le — The police are here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǐngchá is built from *jǐng* 'to warn' and *chá* 'to watch over', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengX* and *tsrheat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be on guard' and the second 'to supervise'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐngchá*
- *Say it: jǐngchá*, once more
- *Say it: jǐngchá lái le* — The police are here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for odd, then the Mandarin for to steal, then say *jǐngchá* again

Before you move on

What does jǐngchá mean? (“Police officer; the police”.) Say it once more.

216.5 bàojǐng — to call the police

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to steal, then the Mandarin for police officer.

You’ll want to know: bàojǐng

bàojǐng — “to call the police”.

wǒmen yào bàojǐng — We’re going to call the police.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàojǐng is built from *bào* ’to report’ and *jǐng* ’to warn’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawH* and *kjaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription).

What you’ve built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàojǐng*
- *Say it: bàojǐng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yào bàojǐng* — We’re going to call the police.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to steal, then the Mandarin for police officer, then say *bàojǐng* again

Before you move on

What does bàojǐng mean? (“To call the police”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 217

Never Mind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say it doesn't matter, say of course, say I remember, ask around and solve a problem.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 217: I can say it doesn't matter, say of course, say I remember, ask around and solve a problem.*

217.1 méi guānxi — it doesn't matter; never mind

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for police officer, then the Mandarin for to call the police.

You'll want to know: méi guānxi

méi guānxi — "it doesn't matter; never mind".

> *méi guānxi wǒmen míngtiān qù* — Never mind, we'll go tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

méi guānxi is built from 没 'not have' and *guānxi* 'a connection', all three parts inherited from Middle Chinese, *mwot*, *kwaen* and *kejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): no connection to worry about.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: méi guānxi*
- *Say it: méi guānxi*, once more
- *Say it: méi guānxi wǒmen míngtiān qù* — Never mind, we'll go tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for police officer, then the Mandarin for to call the police, then say *méi guānxi* again

Before you move on

What does méi guānxi mean? ("It doesn't matter; never mind".) Say it once more.

217.2 dāngrán — of course

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to call the police, then the Mandarin for never mind.

You'll want to know: dāngrán

dāngrán — "of course".

dāngrán kěyǐ — Of course you can.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dāngrán is built from *dāng* 'to match' and *rán* 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'like this' and 'it is so'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngrán*
- *Say it: dāngrán*, once more
- *Say it: dāngrán kěyǐ* — Of course you can.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to call the police, then the Mandarin for never mind, then say *dāngrán* again

Before you move on

What does dāngrán mean? ("Of course".) Say it once more.

217.3 jìde — to remember

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for never mind, then the Mandarin for of course.

You'll want to know: jìde

jìde — "to remember".

nǐ hái jìde wǒ ma — Do you still remember me?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìde is built from *jì* 'to note down' and 得 'to get', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kiH* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìde*
- *Say it: jìde*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ hái jìde wǒ ma* — Do you still remember me?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for never mind, then the Mandarin for of course, then say *jìde* again

Before you move on

What does jìde mean? ("To remember".) Say it once more.

217.4 dǎting — to ask around; to inquire

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for of course, then the Mandarin for to remember.

You'll want to know: dǎting

dǎting — "to ask around; to inquire".

wǒ dǎtingle shūdiàn jīntiān bù kāimén — I asked around, and the bookshop is closed today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎting is built from 打 'to strike' and *tīng* 'to listen', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *theng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎting*
- *Say it: dǎting*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dǎtingle shūdiàn jīntiān bù kāimén* — I asked around, and the bookshop is closed today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for of course, then the Mandarin for to remember, then say *dǎting* again

Before you move on

What does dǎting mean? (“To ask around; to inquire”.) Say it once more.

217.5 jiějué — to solve; to settle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to remember, then the Mandarin for to ask around.

You’ll want to know: jiějué

jiějué — “to solve; to settle”.

zhège wèntí wǒmen néng jiějué — We can sort this problem out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiějué is built from *jiě* ’to untie’ and *jué* ’to break through’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keaX* and *kwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’to explain’ and ’to loosen’, and the second ’to break’.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiějué*
- *Say it: jiějué*, once more
- *Say it: zhège wèntí wǒmen néng jiějué* — We can sort this problem out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to remember, then the Mandarin for to ask around, then say *jiějué* again

Before you move on

What does jiějué mean? ("To solve; to settle".) Say it once more.

217.6 Looking back: from Services in Town to Never Mind

Say the Mandarin for to print out and to photocopy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to print out, to photocopy, to top up, to make an appointment, to get a haircut
- visa, tour guide, tourist, admission ticket, have a safe journey
- problem, to tell someone, to grasp a meaning, a way to deal with it, what should I do
- to deliver goods, to sign for, to leave in safekeeping, laundry shop, to dry-clean
- oh no, odd, to steal, police officer, to call the police
- never mind, of course, to remember, to ask around, to solve

Before you move on

To print out? (*dǎyìn.*) To photocopy? (*fùyìn.*) To top up? (*chōngzhí.*) To make an appointment? (*yùyuē.*) To get a haircut? (*lǐfà.*) Visa? (*qiānzhèng.*) Tour guide? (*dǎoyóu.*) Tourist? (*yóukè.*) Admission ticket? (门票, *ménpiào.*) Have a safe journey? (*yílù píng'ān.*) Problem? (*wèntí.*) To tell someone? (*gàosu.*) To grasp a meaning? (明白, *míngbai.*) A way to deal with it? (*bànfǎ.*) What should I do? (*zěnme bàn.*) To deliver goods? (*sònghuò.*) To sign for? (*qiānshōu.*) To leave in safekeeping? (*jìcún.*) Laundry shop? (洗衣店, *xǐyīdiàn.*) To dry-clean? (*gānxǐ.*) Oh no? (*zāogāo.*) Odd? (*qíguài.*) To steal? (*tōu.*) Police officer? (*jǐngchá.*) To call the police? (*bàojǐng.*) Never mind? (*méi guānxi.*) Of course? (*dāngrán.*)

To remember? (*jìde.*) To ask around? (*dǎting.*) To solve? (*jiějué.*)

217.7 Never Mind — once more

Say the Mandarin for never mind and of course.

Your turn

- *Say it:* never mind, of course, to remember, to ask around, to solve

Before you move on

Never mind? (*méi guānxi.*) Of course? (*dāngrán.*) To remember? (*jìde.*) To ask around? (*dǎting.*) To solve? (*jiějué.*)

Chapter 218

Wind and Warm Days

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a windbreaker, a mild day, muggy heat, dry air and damp.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 218: I can talk about a windbreaker, a mild day, muggy heat, dry air and damp.*

218.1 风衣 (fēngyī) — a windbreaker; a light coat against the wind

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ask around, then the Mandarin for to solve.

You'll want to know: 风衣

风衣 — *fēngyī* — "a windbreaker; a light coat against the wind".

> *chūntiān fēng hěn dà wǒ chángcháng chuān fēngyī* — It's windy in spring, so I often wear a windbreaker.

The new character, in pieces: 风 — four strokes: a long stroke falling to the left, a bar that turns and hooks down to the right, and inside them a short stroke to the left and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

风衣 (*fēngyī*) is built from 风 'wind' and 衣 'garment', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwng* and *'j+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the first, after an older book, as the messenger of heaven and earth.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēngyī*
- *Say it: fēngyī*, once more
- *Say it: chūntiān fēng hěn dà wǒ chángcháng chuān fēngyī* — It's windy in spring, so I often wear a windbreaker.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ask around, then the Mandarin for to solve, then say *fēngyī* again

Before you move on

What does 风衣 mean? ("A windbreaker; a light coat against the wind".) Say it once more.

218.2 风 — a frame, and two short strokes inside

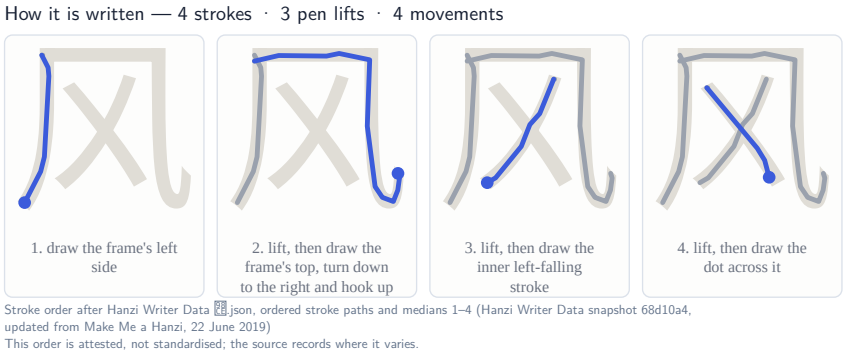
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *fēngyī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  衣 气

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yī*, *qì*

Script — a frame, and two short strokes inside



How 风 is written, stroke by stroke

风

Two pieces: a frame, then what sits inside it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The frame, two strokes. A long stroke falling to the left, from the top down to the foot. Then a bar from its top that runs right, turns and falls to the lower right, flicking up at its end.

Inside, two strokes. A short stroke falling to the left, then a dot falling to the right across it, like a small cross.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 风, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 风? (**Four**.) What comes first? (**The long stroke falling to the left**.) What sits inside? (**A short fall to the left and a dot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 风, pinned stroke paths and medians.

218.3 nuǎnhuo — pleasantly warm; mild

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to solve, then the Mandarin for a windbreaker.

You'll want to know: nuǎnhuo

nuǎnhuo — "pleasantly warm; mild".

jīntiān hěn nuǎnhuo — It's lovely and warm today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nuǎnhuo is built from *nuǎn* 'warm' and *huo* 'mild', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nwanX* and *hwa* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first beside another character glossed 'warm', and glosses the second 'in harmony' and 'neither hard nor soft'; in the word the second loses its tone and its vowel changes.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: nuǎnhuo*
- *Say it: nuǎnhuo*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān hěn nuǎnhuo* — It's lovely and warm today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to solve, then the Mandarin for a windbreaker, then say *nuǎnhuo* again

Before you move on

What does nuǎnhuo mean? ("Pleasantly warm; mild".) Say it once more.

218.4 mēnrè — hot and stuffy; muggy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a windbreaker, then the Mandarin for pleasantly warm.

You'll want to know: mēnrè

mēnrè — "hot and stuffy; muggy".

jīntiān tài mēnrè le — It's so muggy today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mēnrè is built from *mēn* 'stifled' and *rè* 'hot', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mwonH* and *nyet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'vexed' and explains the second as burning, as if by fire. The first is listed with a departing tone, so the level tone of mēn is not the regular outcome.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēnrè*
- *Say it: mēnrè*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān tài mēnrè le* — It's so muggy today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a windbreaker, then the Mandarin for pleasantly warm, then say *mēnrè* again

Before you move on

What does mēnrè mean? ("Hot and stuffy; muggy".) Say it once more.

218.5 gānzào — dry air; dry (of weather or skin)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pleasantly warm, then the Mandarin for hot and stuffy.

You'll want to know: gānzào

gānzào — "dry air; dry (of weather or skin)".

dōngtiān zhèr hěn gānzào — Winters here are very dry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gānzào is built from *gān* 'dry' and *zào* 'parched'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *kan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second, *sawX* there, with this very word, 'dry'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: gānzào*
- *Say it: gānzào*, once more
- *Say it: dōngtiān zhèr hěn gānzào* — Winters here are very dry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pleasantly warm, then the Mandarin for hot and stuffy, then say *gānzào* again

Before you move on

What does gānzào mean? ("Dry air; dry (of weather or skin)".) Say it once more.

218.6 cháoshī — damp; humid

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hot and stuffy, then the Mandarin for dry air.

You'll want to know: cháoshī

cháoshī — "damp; humid".

> *xiàtiān zhèr hěn cháoshī* — Summers here are very humid.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cháoshī is built from *cháo* 'tide' and *shī* 'wet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjew* and *syip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'tide water' and the second 'soaked with water'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: cháoshī*
- *Say it: cháoshī*, once more
- *Say it: xiàtiān zhèr hěn cháoshī* — Summers here are very humid.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hot and stuffy, then the Mandarin for dry air, then say *cháoshī* again

Before you move on

What does cháoshī mean? ("Damp; humid".) Say it once more.

Chapter 219

Cloudy Tomorrow

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say there will be cloud, a cloudy day, a cold snap, what the temperature is and when it will clear.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 219: I can say there will be cloud, a cloudy day, a cold snap, what the temperature is and when it will clear.*

219.1 云 (yún) — cloud

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dry air, then the Mandarin for damp.

You'll want to know: 云

云 — *yún* — "cloud".

> 明天下午会有云 *míngtiān xiàwǔ huì yǒu yún* — There'll be some cloud tomorrow afternoon.

The new character, in pieces: 云 — four strokes: two bars, then a stroke that falls to the left and turns right along the foot, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

云 (*yún*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains it, after an older book, as the vapour of mountains and rivers. The dictionary writes the word for cloud with 雨 on top, and lists 云 as the older way of writing it.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yún*
- *Say it: yún*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān xiàwǔ huì yǒu yún* — There'll be some cloud tomorrow afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dry air, then the Mandarin for damp, then say *yún* again

Before you move on

What does 云 mean? ("Cloud".) Say it once more.

219.2 云 — two bars, then a turn and a dot

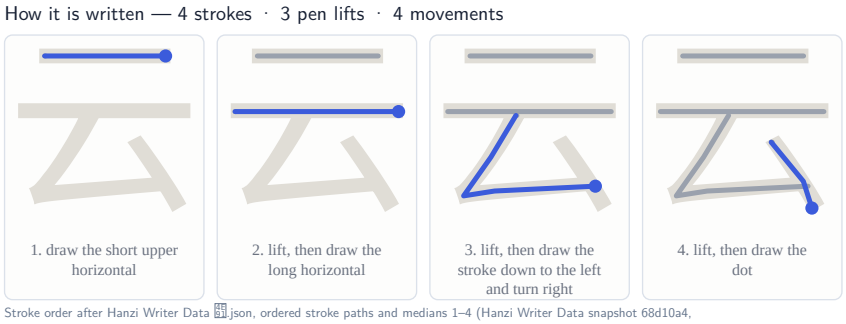
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yún* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

二 雨

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *èr*, *yǔ*

Script — two bars, then a turn and a dot



How 云 is written, stroke by stroke

云

Two pieces, top before bottom.

On top, 二, two strokes: a short bar, then a longer one under it.

Under it, two strokes. A stroke falling to the left that turns and runs right along the foot. Then a dot at the right, above the end of that stroke, falling to the right.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 云, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 云? (**Four**.) What is on top? (**二, two bars**.) What does the third stroke do? (**It falls to the left and turns right**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 云, pinned stroke paths and medians.

219.3 多云 (duōyún) — cloudy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for damp, then the Mandarin for a cloud.

You'll want to know: 多云

多云 — *duōyún* — "cloudy".

明天多云风不大 *míngtiān duōyún fēng bú dà* — Tomorrow will be cloudy, without much wind.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

多云 (*duōyún*) is built from 多 'many' and 云 'cloud', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ta* and *hjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: duōyún*
- *Say it: duōyún*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān duōyún fēng bú dà* — Tomorrow will be cloudy, without much wind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for damp, then the Mandarin for a cloud, then say *duōyún* again

Before you move on

What does 多云 mean? ("Cloudy".) Say it once more.

219.4 jiàngwēn — to turn colder; to cool down

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a cloud, then the Mandarin for cloudy.

You'll want to know: jiàngwēn

jiàngwēn — "to turn colder; to cool down".

> *hòutiān huì jiàngwēn* — It's going to turn colder the day after tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàngwēn is built from *jiàng* 'to come down' and *wēn* 'warm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngH* and *'won* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'down' and 'to fall', and the second, among other senses, 'mild' and 'warm'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàngwēn*
- *Say it: jiàngwēn*, once more
- *Say it: hòutiān huì jiàngwēn* — It's going to turn colder the day after tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a cloud, then the Mandarin for cloudy, then say *jiàngwēn* again

Before you move on

What does jiàngwēn mean? ("To turn colder; to cool down".) Say it once more.

219.5 qìwēn — air temperature

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cloudy, then the Mandarin for to turn colder.

You'll want to know: qìwēn

qìwēn — "air temperature".

> *jīntiān de qìwēn bǐ zuótiān gāo* — It's warmer today than yesterday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qìwēn is built from 气 'air' and *wēn* 'warm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khj+jH* and *'won* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'breath'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: qìwēn*
- *Say it: qìwēn*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de qìwēn bǐ zuótiān gāo* — It's warmer today than yesterday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cloudy, then the Mandarin for to turn colder, then say *qìwēn* again

Before you move on

What does qìwēn mean? ("Air temperature".) Say it once more.

219.6 fàngqíng — to clear up (of the sky)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn colder, then the Mandarin for air temperature.

You'll want to know: fàngqíng

fàngqíng — "to clear up (of the sky)".

> *xiàwǔ huì fàngqíng* — It'll clear up in the afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàngqíng is built from *fàng* 'to let go' and *qíng* 'clear'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to drive out'; the dictionary glosses the second, *dzjeng* there, 'a clear sky'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàngqíng*
- *Say it: fàngqíng*, once more
- *Say it: xiàwǔ huì fàngqíng* — It'll clear up in the afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn colder, then the Mandarin for air temperature, then say *fàngqíng* again

Before you move on

What does fàngqíng mean? ("To clear up (of the sky)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 220

Keeping Fit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about working out, losing weight, sweating, skipping and doing exercises.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 220: I can talk about working out, losing weight, sweating, skipping and doing exercises.*

220.1 jiànshēn — to work out; to keep fit

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for air temperature, then the Mandarin for to clear up.

You'll want to know: jiànshēn

jiànshēn — "to work out; to keep fit".

> *wǒ měitiān xiàwǔ qù jiànshēn* — I go and work out every afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiànshēn is built from *jiàn* 'strong' and *shēn* 'body', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjonH* and *syin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'sturdy' and the second 'oneself' and 'the body'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànshēn*
- *Say it: jiànshēn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān xiàwǔ qù jiànshēn* — I go and work out every afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for air temperature, then the Mandarin for to clear up, then say *jiànshēn* again

Before you move on

What does jiànshēn mean? ("To work out; to keep fit".) Say it once more.

220.2 jiǎnféi — to lose weight; to diet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to clear up, then the Mandarin for to work out.

You'll want to know: jiǎnféi

jiǎnféi — "to lose weight; to diet".

wǒ jiějie zhèngzài jiǎnféi — My big sister is trying to lose weight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎnféi is built from *jiǎn* 'to reduce' and *féi* 'fat'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *bj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), explained after an older book as having much flesh; the dictionary glosses the first, *keamX* there, 'to lessen'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎnféi*
- *Say it: jiǎnféi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiějie zhèngzài jiǎnféi* — My big sister is trying to lose weight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to clear up, then the Mandarin for to work out, then say *jiǎnféi* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎnféi mean? ("To lose weight; to diet".) Say it once more.

220.3 chūhàn — to sweat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to work out, then the Mandarin for to lose weight.

You'll want to know: chūhàn

chūhàn — "to sweat".

tiān tài rè le wǒ chūhàn le — It's so hot that I'm sweating.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūhàn is built from 出 'to come out' and *hàn* 'sweat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *hanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'hot sweat'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūhàn*
- *Say it: chūhàn*, once more
- *Say it: tiān tài rè le wǒ chūhàn le* — It's so hot that I'm sweating.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to work out, then the Mandarin for to lose weight, then say *chūhàn* again

Before you move on

What does chūhàn mean? ("To sweat".) Say it once more.

220.4 tiàoshéng — to skip with a rope

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lose weight, then the Mandarin for to sweat.

You'll want to know: tiàoshéng

tiàoshéng — "to skip with a rope".

wǒ nǚ'ér měitiān tiàoshéng — My daughter skips every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiàoshéng is built from *tiào* 'to jump' and *shéng* 'rope'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *dew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to leap', whose regular outcome is tiáo, not the falling tiào; the dictionary glosses the second, *zying* there, 'straight' and 'a cord'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiàoshéng*
- *Say it: tiàoshéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nǚ'ér měitiān tiàoshéng* — My daughter skips every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lose weight, then the Mandarin for to sweat, then say *tiàoshéng* again

Before you move on

What does tiàoshéng mean? ("To skip with a rope".) Say it once more.

220.5 zuòcāo — to do a fitness routine; to do physical exercises

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sweat, then the Mandarin for to skip with a rope.

You'll want to know: zuòcāo

zuòcāo — "to do a fitness routine; to do physical exercises".

wǒ bàba měitiān zǎoshang zuòcāo — My dad does his exercises every morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuòcāo is built from 做 'to do' and *cāo* 'a drill'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshaw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to hold'; how it came to mean a drill is not settled. No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòcāo*
- *Say it: zuòcāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba měitiān zǎoshang zuòcāo* — My dad does his exercises every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sweat, then the Mandarin for to skip with a rope, then say *zuòcāo* again

Before you move on

What does zuòcāo mean? ("To do a fitness routine; to do physical exercises".) Say it once more.

Chapter 221

Snow and Ice

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a snowman, skiing, ice, being below zero and gloves.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 221: I can talk about a snowman, skiing, ice, being below zero and gloves.*

221.1 雪人 (xuěrén) — snowman

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to skip with a rope, then the Mandarin for to do a fitness routine.

You'll want to know: 雪人

雪人 — *xuěrén* — "snowman".

> 门口有一个雪人 *ménkǒu yǒu yí ge xuěrén* — There's a snowman by the door.

The new character, in pieces: 雪 — eleven strokes in two pieces: 雨 pressed flat on top, eight strokes, and under it three bars joined on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

雪人 (*xuěrén*) is built from 雪 'snow' and 人 'person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjwet* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'frozen rain'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuěrén*
- *Say it: xuěrén*, once more
- *Say it: ménkǒu yǒu yí ge xuěrén* — There's a snowman by the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to skip with a rope, then the Mandarin for to do a fitness routine, then say *xuěrén* again

Before you move on

What does 雪人 mean? ("Snowman".) Say it once more.

221.2 雪 — 雨 on top, three bars below

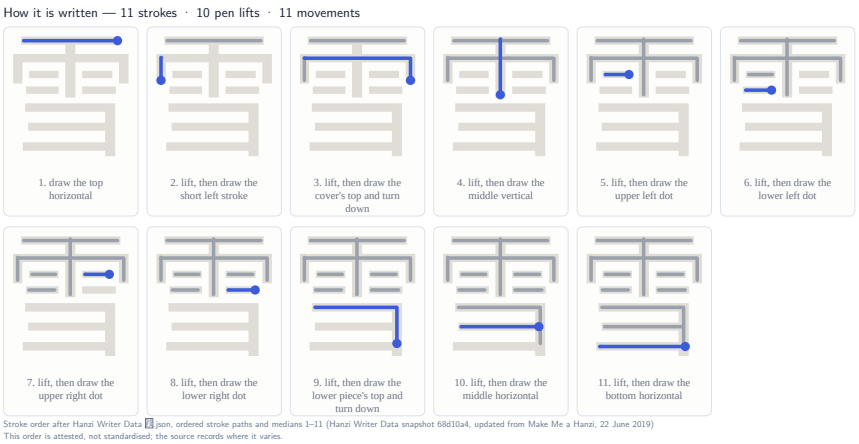
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xuěrén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

雨 白

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yǔ*, *bái*

Script — 雨 on top, three bars below



How 雪 is written, stroke by stroke

雪

Two pieces, top before bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

On top, 雨, eight strokes, pressed flat: a short bar; a short stroke down on the left; a bar that runs right and turns down with a hook; a vertical through the middle; then four dots, two on the left and two on the right.

Under it, three strokes. A bar that runs right and turns down, a bar across the middle, and a bar along the foot, all three meeting the stroke on the right.

8 + 3 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 雪, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 雪? (**Eleven.**) What is on top? (**雨, pressed flat.**) How many bars at the foot? (**Three.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 雪, pinned stroke paths and medians.

221.3 huáxuě — to ski

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to do a fitness routine, then the Mandarin for a snowman.

You'll want to know: huáxuě

huáxuě — "to ski".

nǐ huì huáxuě ma — Can you ski?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huáxuě is built from *huá* 'slippery' and 雪 'snow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweat* and *sjwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary's gloss for the first is 'keen' or 'smooth', not 'slippery', so how it came to that sense is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: huáxuě*
- *Say it: huáxuě*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ huì huáxuě ma* — Can you ski?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to do a fitness routine, then the Mandarin for a snowman, then say *huáxuě* again

Before you move on

What does huáxuě mean? ("To ski".) Say it once more.

221.4 bīng — ice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a snowman, then the Mandarin for to ski.

You'll want to know: bīng

bīng — "ice".

bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu bīng — There's ice in the fridge.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bīng is inherited from Middle Chinese *ping* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'water frozen'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīng*
- *Say it: bīng*, once more
- *Say it: bīngxiāng lǐ yǒu bīng* — There's ice in the fridge.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a snowman, then the Mandarin for to ski, then say *bīng* again

Before you move on

What does bīng mean? ("Ice".) Say it once more.

221.5 língxià — below zero

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ski, then the Mandarin for ice.

You'll want to know: língxià

língxià — "below zero".

> *jīntiān língxià wàibian hěn lěng* — It's below zero today; it's freezing outside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

língxià is built from *líng* 'zero' and 下 'below', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *leng* and *haeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to fall' and 'a gentle rain', so the sense zero came later, and how is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: língxià*
- *Say it: língxià*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān língxià wàibian hěn lěng* — It's below zero today; it's freezing outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ski, then the Mandarin for ice, then say *língxià* again

Before you move on

What does língxià mean? ("Below zero".) Say it once more.

221.6 shǒutào — gloves

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ice, then the Mandarin for below zero.

You'll want to know: shǒutào

shǒutào — "gloves".

> *wàibian hěn lěng nǐ dài shǒutào le ma* — It's cold out. Have you got your gloves?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǒutào is built from 手 'hand' and *tào* 'a cover', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *thawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'long', so how it came to mean a cover is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒutào*
- *Say it: shǒutào*, once more
- *Say it: wàibian hěn lěng nǐ dài shǒutào le ma* — It's cold out. Have you got your gloves?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ice, then the Mandarin for below zero, then say *shǒutào* again

Before you move on

What does shǒutào mean? ("Gloves".) Say it once more.

Chapter 222

Under the Weather

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I caught a chill, I have a cough and a sore throat, I keep sneezing, and why I feel awful.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 222: I can say I caught a chill, I have a cough and a sore throat, I keep sneezing, and why I feel awful.*

222.1 zháoliáng — to catch a chill

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for below zero, then the Mandarin for gloves.

You'll want to know: zháoliáng

zháoliáng — "to catch a chill".

> *zuótiān wǒ zháoliáng le* — I caught a chill yesterday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zháoliáng is built from *zháo* 'to be touched by' and *liáng* 'cool', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjak* and *ljang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to attach to' and the second 'thin' and 'cold'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zháoliáng*
- *Say it: zháoliáng*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān wǒ zháoliáng le* — I caught a chill yesterday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for below zero, then the Mandarin for gloves, then say *zháoliáng* again

Before you move on

What does zháoliáng mean? ("To catch a chill".) Say it once more.

222.2 késou — to cough

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for gloves, then the Mandarin for to catch a chill.

You'll want to know: késou

késou — "to cough".

wǒ yǒudiǎnr késou — I've got a bit of a cough.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

késou is built from *ké* and *sou*. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *suwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), listed with a character for coughing; the dictionary reads the first only as a small child's laugh, so how it came to mean coughing is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: késou*
- *Say it: késou*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒudiǎnr késou* — I've got a bit of a cough.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for gloves, then the Mandarin for to catch a chill, then say *késou* again

Before you move on

What does késou mean? ("To cough".) Say it once more.

222.3 sǎngzi — throat; voice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to catch a chill, then the Mandarin for to cough.

You'll want to know: sǎngzi

sǎngzi — "throat; voice".

wǒ sǎngzi téng — My throat hurts.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sǎngzi is built from *sǎng* 'throat' and the noun ending 子, inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǎngzi*
- *Say it: sǎngzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ sǎngzi téng* — My throat hurts.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to catch a chill, then the Mandarin for to cough, then say *sǎngzi* again

Before you move on

What does sǎngzi mean? ("Throat; voice".) Say it once more.

222.4 dǎ pēntì — to sneeze

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to cough, then the Mandarin for throat.

You'll want to know: dǎ pēntì

dǎ pēntì — "to sneeze".

gǎnmào de shíhou wǒ chángcháng dǎ pēntì — When I've got a cold I sneeze a lot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎ pēntì is built from 打 'to strike, to do' and *pēntì* 'a sneeze', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX*, *phwonH* and *tejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to breathe out' and the third 'breath from the nose'. Neither dǎ nor the level tone of pēn is the regular outcome of the form listed.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎ pēntì*
- *Say it: dǎ pēntì*, once more
- *Say it: gǎnmào de shíhou wǒ chángcháng dǎ pēntì* — When I've got a cold I sneeze a lot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to cough, then the Mandarin for throat, then say *dǎ pēntì* again

Before you move on

What does dǎ pēntì mean? ("To sneeze".) Say it once more.

222.5 nánshòu — miserable; unwell

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for throat, then the Mandarin for to sneeze.

You'll want to know: nánshòu

nánshòu — "miserable; unwell".

yīnwèi gǎnmào le wǒ hěn nánshòu — I feel awful because I've got a cold.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nánshòu is built from *nán* 'hard' and *shòu* 'to bear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan* and *dzyuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'difficult' and the second 'to hold' and 'to receive'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánshòu*
- *Say it: nánshòu*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi gǎnmào le wǒ hěn nánshòu* — I feel awful because I've got a cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for throat, then the Mandarin for to sneeze, then say *nánshòu* again

Before you move on

What does nánshòu mean? ("Miserable; unwell".) Say it once more.

Chapter 223

Animals

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name animals: a panda, a tiger, a monkey and a rabbit, and say which ones I like.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 223: I can name animals: a panda, a tiger, a monkey and a rabbit, and say which ones I like.*

223.1 dòngwù — animal

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sneeze, then the Mandarin for miserable.

You'll want to know: dòngwù

dòngwù — "animal".

> *nǐ xǐhuan shénme dòngwù* — What animals do you like?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dòngwù is built from *dòng* 'to move' and *wù* 'thing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwngX* and *mjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to shake' and the second 'the ten thousand things'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: dòngwù*
- *Say it: dòngwù*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xǐhuan shénme dòngwù* — What animals do you like?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sneeze, then the Mandarin for miserable, then say *dòngwù* again

Before you move on

What does dòngwù mean? ("Animal".) Say it once more.

223.2 xióngmāo — a panda; giant panda

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for miserable, then the Mandarin for an animal.

You'll want to know: xióngmāo

xióngmāo — "a panda; giant panda".

xióngmāo hěn kě'ài — Pandas are so cute.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xióngmāo is built from *xióng* 'bear' and *māo* 'cat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwng* and *mjew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the first as a beast like a pig and the second as the animal that catches mice; the level tone of māo is not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xióngmāo*
- *Say it: xióngmāo*, once more
- *Say it: xióngmāo hěn kě'ài* — Pandas are so cute.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for miserable, then the Mandarin for an animal, then say *xióngmāo* again

Before you move on

What does xióngmāo mean? ("A panda; giant panda".) Say it once more.

223.3 lǎohǔ — tiger

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an animal, then the Mandarin for a panda.

You'll want to know: lǎohǔ

lǎohǔ — "tiger".

wǒ mèimei pà lǎohǔ — My little sister is scared of tigers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Tone: lǎo and hǔ are both third tones, so the first rises and it sounds like láohǔ.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǎohǔ is built from *lǎo* 'old' and *hǔ* 'tiger', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lawX* and *xuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which calls the second, after an older book, the lord of the mountain beasts. Here the first is a prefix with no sense of age; how it came to sit there is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǎohǔ*
- *Say it: lǎohǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mèimei pà lǎohǔ* — My little sister is scared of tigers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an animal, then the Mandarin for a panda, then say *lǎohǔ* again

Before you move on

What does lǎohǔ mean? ("Tiger".) Say it once more.

223.4 hóuzi — monkey

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a panda, then the Mandarin for a tiger.

You'll want to know: hóuzi

hóuzi — "monkey".

nà zhī hóuzi hěn cōngming — That monkey's very clever.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hóuzi is built from *hóu* 'monkey' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huw* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with a word for the macaque.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: hóuzi*
- *Say it: hóuzi*, once more

- *Say it: nà zhī hóuzi hěn cōngming* — That monkey's very clever.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a panda, then the Mandarin for a tiger, then say *hóuzi* again

Before you move on

What does hóuzi mean? ("Monkey".) Say it once more.

223.5 tùzi — rabbit; hare

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tiger, then the Mandarin for a monkey.

You'll want to know: tùzi

tùzi — "rabbit; hare".

wǒ jiā yǒu liǎng zhī tùzi — We've got two rabbits at home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tùzi is built from a word for the hare and the noun ending 子. The noun ending is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), and the dictionary lists the first as the name of a beast.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: tùzi*
- *Say it: tùzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā yǒu liǎng zhī tùzi* — We've got two rabbits at home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tiger, then the Mandarin for a monkey, then say *tùzi* again

Before you move on

What does tùzi mean? ("Rabbit; hare".) Say it once more.

223.6 Looking back: from Wind and Warm Days to Animals

Say the Mandarin for a windbreaker and pleasantly warm.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a windbreaker, pleasantly warm, hot and stuffy, dry air, damp
- *Say it:* a cloud, cloudy, to turn colder, air temperature, to clear up
- *Say it:* to work out, to lose weight, to sweat, to skip with a rope, to do a fitness routine
- *Say it:* a snowman, to ski, ice, below zero, gloves
- *Say it:* to catch a chill, to cough, throat, to sneeze, miserable
- *Say it:* an animal, a panda, a tiger, a monkey, a rabbit
- *Read it:* 风 云 雪 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A windbreaker? (风衣, *fēngyī.*) Pleasantly warm? (*nuǎnhuo.*) Hot and stuffy? (*mēnrè.*) Dry air? (*gānzào.*) Damp? (*cháoshī.*) A cloud? (云, *yún.*) Cloudy? (多云, *duōyún.*) To turn colder? (*jiàngwēn.*) Air temperature? (*qìwēn.*) To clear up? (*fàngqíng.*) To work out? (*jiànshēn.*) To lose weight? (*jiǎnféi.*) To sweat? (*chūhàn.*) To skip with a rope? (*tiàoshéng.*) To do a fitness routine? (*zuòcāo.*) A snowman? (雪人, *xuěrén.*) To ski? (*huáxuě.*) Ice? (*bīng.*) Below zero? (*língxià.*) Gloves? (*shǒutào.*) To catch a chill? (*zháoliáng.*) To cough? (*késou.*) Throat? (*sǎngzi.*) To sneeze? (*dǎ pēntì.*) Miserable? (*nánshòu.*) An animal? (*dòngwù.*) A panda? (*xióngmāo.*) A tiger? (*lǎohǔ.*) A monkey? (*hóuzi.*) A rabbit? (*tùzi.*)

Chapter 224

Spring Flowers

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say flowers are coming out, and talk about a florist's, a garden, butterflies and bees.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 224: I can say flowers are coming out, and talk about a florist's, a garden, butterflies and bees.*

224.1 开花 (kāihuā) — to bloom; to flower

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a monkey, then the Mandarin for a rabbit.

You'll want to know: 开花

开花 — *kāihuā* — "to bloom; to flower".

> 这些花三月开花 *zhèxiē huā sānyuè kāihuā* — These flowers come out in March.

The new character, in pieces: 花 — seven strokes: the grass piece of 菜 on top, then the person piece, then two strokes like the right half of 比. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开花 (*kāihuā*) is built from 开 'to open' and 花 'flower', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *xwae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which notes the second as the everyday form of the word for blossom.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāihuā*
- *Say it: kāihuā*, once more
- *Say it: zhèxiē huā sānyuè kāihuā* — These flowers come out in March.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a monkey, then the Mandarin for a rabbit, then say *kāihuā* again

Before you move on

What does 开花 mean? ("To bloom; to flower".) Say it once more.

224.2 花 — the grass piece over the person piece and two more strokes

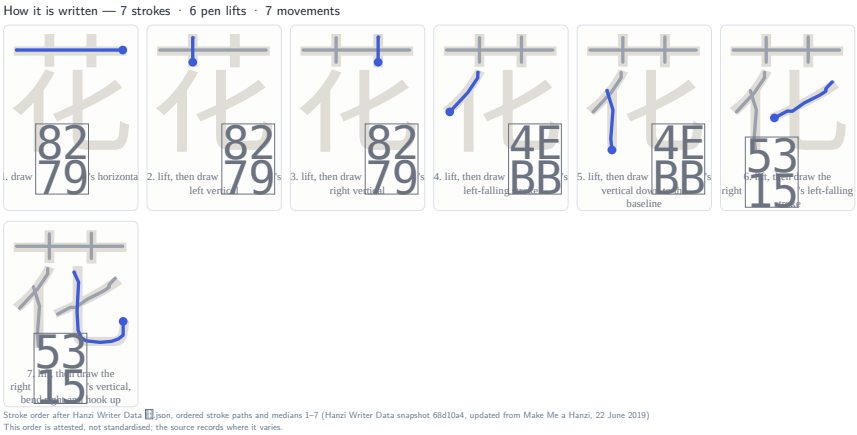
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kāihuā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  菜 比

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *cài*, *bǐ*

Script — the grass piece over the person piece and two more strokes



How 花 is written, stroke by stroke

花

Three pieces: one on top, two side by side under it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The grass piece, three strokes, as in 菜 and 茶: a bar across, then two short verticals through it.

The person piece, 亻, two strokes, as in 你: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical.

The right piece, two strokes, like the right half of 比: a short stroke falling to the left, then a vertical that bends right along the foot and flicks up.

3 + 2 + 2 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 花, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 花? (**Seven.**) What is on top? (**The grass piece of** 菜.) Which piece comes next? (亻**, the person piece.**) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 花, pinned stroke paths and medians.

224.3 花店 (huādiàn) — florist's; flower shop

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a rabbit, then the Mandarin for to bloom.

You'll want to know: 花店

花店 — *huādiàn* — "florist's; flower shop".

我去花店买花 *wǒ qù huādiàn mǎi huā* — I'm going to the florist's to buy flowers.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

花店 (*huādiàn*) is built from 花 'flower' and 店 'shop', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwae* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: huādiàn*
- *Say it: huādiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù huādiàn mǎi huā* — I'm going to the florist's to buy flowers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a rabbit, then the Mandarin for to bloom, then say *huādiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 花店 mean? ("Florist's; flower shop".) Say it once more.

224.4 huāyuán — garden

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to bloom, then the Mandarin for a florist's.

You'll want to know: huāyuán

huāyuán — "garden".

wǒ jiā hòubian yǒu yí ge huāyuán — There's a garden behind our house.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huāyuán is built from 花 'flower' and *yuán* 'a plot', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwae* and *hjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a garden plot'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: huāyuán*
- *Say it: huāyuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiā hòubian yǒu yí ge huāyuán* — There's a garden behind our house.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to bloom, then the Mandarin for a florist's, then say *huāyuán* again

Before you move on

What does huāyuán mean? ("Garden".) Say it once more.

224.5 húdié — butterfly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a florist's, then the Mandarin for a garden.

You'll want to know: húdié

húdié — "butterfly".

huāyuán lǐ yǒu liǎng zhī húdié — There are two butterflies in the garden.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

húdié is built from two characters, and the dictionary glosses the second, *dep* there (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), as a butterfly. No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: húdié*
- *Say it: húdié*, once more
- *Say it: huāyuán lǐ yǒu liǎng zhī húdié* — There are two butterflies in the garden.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a florist's, then the Mandarin for a garden, then say *húdié* again

Before you move on

What does húdié mean? ("Butterfly".) Say it once more.

224.6 mìfēng — bee; honeybee

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a garden, then the Mandarin for a butterfly.

You'll want to know: mìfēng

mìfēng — "bee; honeybee".

huāyuán lǐ de huā kāi le mìfēng yě lái le — The flowers in the garden are out, and the bees have come too.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mìfēng is built from *mì* 'honey' and *fēng* 'bee', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjit* and *phjowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the food bees make and explains the second, after an older book, as a flying insect that stings.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: mìfēng*
- *Say it: mìfēng*, once more
- *Say it: huāyuán lǐ de huā kāi le mìfēng yě lái le* — The flowers in the garden are out, and the bees have come too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a garden, then the Mandarin for a butterfly, then say *mìfēng* again

Before you move on

What does mìfēng mean? (“Bee; honeybee”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 225

In the Country

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the countryside, farmers, working the land, picking fruit and camping.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 225: I can talk about the countryside, farmers, working the land, picking fruit and camping.*

225.1 nóngcūn — the countryside; a farming village

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a butterfly, then the Mandarin for a bee.

You'll want to know: nóngcūn

nóngcūn — "the countryside; a farming village".

> *wǒ lǎojiā zài nóngcūn* — My home town is out in the countryside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nóngcūn is built from *nóng* 'farming' and *cūn* 'village', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nowng* and *tshwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'farming the fields' and the second 'a farmstead'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nóngcūn*
- *Say it: nóngcūn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ lǎojiā zài nóngcūn* — My home town is out in the countryside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a butterfly, then the Mandarin for a bee, then say *nóngcūn* again

Before you move on

What does nóngcūn mean? ("The countryside; a farming village".) Say it once more.

225.2 nóngmín — farmer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bee, then the Mandarin for the countryside.

You'll want to know: nóngmín

nóngmín — "farmer".

tā bàba shì nóngmín — His dad is a farmer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nóngmín is built from *nóng* 'farming' and *mín* 'the people', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nowng* and *mjin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the second, after an older book, as the multitude.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nóngmín*
- *Say it: nóngmín*, once more
- *Say it: tā bàba shì nóngmín* — His dad is a farmer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bee, then the Mandarin for the countryside, then say *nóngmín* again

Before you move on

What does nóngmín mean? ("Farmer".) Say it once more.

225.3 zhòngdì — to farm; to work the land

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the countryside, then the Mandarin for a farmer.

You'll want to know: zhòngdì

zhòngdì — "to farm; to work the land".

nóngmín měitiān zhòngdì — Farmers work the land every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhòngdì is built from *zhòng* 'to plant' and 地 'land', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyowngH* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to plant in the soil'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòngdì*
- *Say it: zhòngdì*, once more
- *Say it: nóngmín měitiān zhòngdì* — Farmers work the land every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the countryside, then the Mandarin for a farmer, then say *zhòngdì* again

Before you move on

What does zhòngdì mean? ("To farm; to work the land".) Say it once more.

225.4 zhāi — to pick fruit; to pick flowers

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a farmer, then the Mandarin for to work the land.

You'll want to know: zhāi

zhāi — "to pick fruit; to pick flowers".

wǒmen qù nóngcūn zhāi píngguǒ — We're going to the countryside to pick apples.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhāi is inherited from Middle Chinese *treak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to take with the hand'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhāi*
- *Say it: zhāi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù nóngcūn zhāi píngguǒ* — We're going to the countryside to pick apples.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a farmer, then the Mandarin for to work the land, then say *zhāi* again

Before you move on

What does zhāi mean? ("To pick fruit; to pick flowers".) Say it once more.

225.5 lùyíng — to camp out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to work the land, then the Mandarin for to pick fruit.

You'll want to know: lùyíng

lùyíng — "to camp out".

zhōumò wǒmen qù lùyíng — We're going camping at the weekend.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lùyíng is built from *lù* 'dew, the open air' and *yíng* 'a camp'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *yweng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to build'; the dictionary explains the first, *luH* there, as dew. How the pair came to mean camping is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùyíng*
- *Say it: lùyíng*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen qù lùyíng* — We're going camping at the weekend.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to work the land, then the Mandarin for to pick fruit, then say *lùyíng* again

Before you move on

What does lùyíng mean? ("To camp out".) Say it once more.

Chapter 226

Grass and Lakes

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a lawn, a lake, a forest, grassland and the scenery.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 226: I can describe a lawn, a lake, a forest, grassland and the scenery.*

226.1 草地 (cǎodì) — lawn; grassy ground

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pick fruit, then the Mandarin for to camp out.

You'll want to know: 草地

草地 — *cǎodì* — "lawn; grassy ground".

> *gōngyuán lǐ yǒu yí kuài dà cǎodì* — There's a big lawn in the park.

The new character, in pieces: 草 — nine strokes: the grass piece of 菜 on top, then 早 under it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

草地 (*cǎodì*) is built from 草 'grass' and 地 'ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshawX* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'all the plants'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: cǎodì*
- *Say it: cǎodì*, once more
- *Say it: gōngyuán lǐ yǒu yí kuài dà cǎodì* — There's a big lawn in the park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pick fruit, then the Mandarin for to camp out, then say *cǎodì* again

Before you move on

What does 草地 mean? ("Lawn; grassy ground".) Say it once more.

226.2 草 — the grass piece over 早

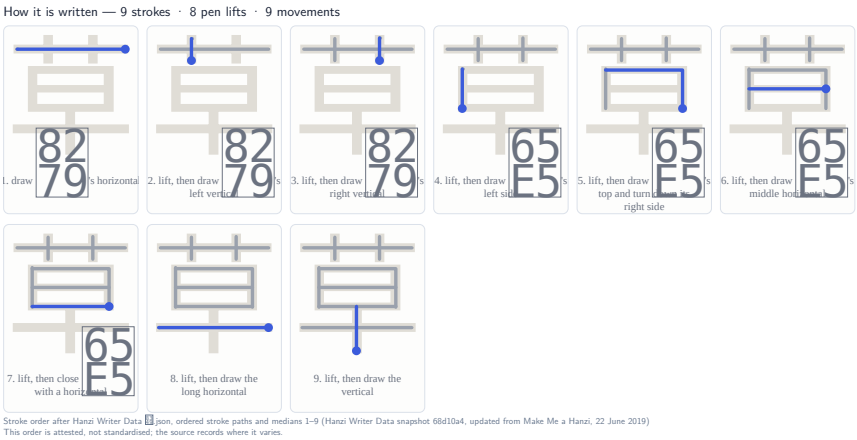
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *cǎodì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  早 花

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zǎo*, *huā*

Script — the grass piece over 早



How 草 is written, stroke by stroke

草

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The grass piece, three strokes, as in 菜 and 花: a bar across, then two short verticals.

Under it, 早, six strokes, as in 早上: 日, four strokes, then a long bar across and a vertical down through its middle.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 草, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 草? (**Nine.**) What sits under the grass piece? (早.) What comes last? (**The long vertical through the middle.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 草, pinned stroke paths and medians.

226.3 hú — lake

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to camp out, then the Mandarin for a lawn.

You'll want to know: hú

hú — "lake".

gōngyuán lǐ yǒu yí ge hú — There's a lake in the park.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hú is inherited from Middle Chinese *hu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains it as a broad body of water.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: hú*
- *Say it: hú*, once more
- *Say it: gōngyuán lǐ yǒu yí ge hú* — There's a lake in the park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to camp out, then the Mandarin for a lawn, then say *hú* again

Before you move on

What does hú mean? ("Lake".) Say it once more.

226.4 sēnlín — forest

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a lawn, then the Mandarin for a lake.

You'll want to know: sēnlín

sēnlín — "forest".

> *sēnlín lǐ hěn ānjìng* — It's very quiet in the forest.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sēnlín is built from *sēn* 'dense with trees' and *lín* 'woods'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *lim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'trees'; the dictionary describes the first, *srim* there, as how tall trees look.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: sēnlín*
- *Say it: sēnlín*, once more
- *Say it: sēnlín lǐ hěn ānjìng* — It's very quiet in the forest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a lawn, then the Mandarin for a lake, then say *sēnlín* again

Before you move on

What does sēnlín mean? ("Forest".) Say it once more.

226.5 cǎoyuán — grassland; prairie

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a lake, then the Mandarin for a forest.

You'll want to know: cǎoyuán

cǎoyuán — "grassland; prairie".

> *wǒ xiǎng qù cǎoyuán qí mǎ* — I'd love to go riding on the grasslands.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cǎoyuán is built from 草 'grass' and *yuán* 'a plain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshawX* and *ngjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'broad and flat'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: cǎoyuán*
- *Say it: cǎoyuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng qù cǎoyuán qí mǎ* — I'd love to go riding on the grasslands.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a lake, then the Mandarin for a forest, then say *cǎoyuán* again

Before you move on

What does cǎoyuán mean? ("Grassland; prairie".) Say it once more.

226.6 fēngjǐng — scenery; landscape

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a forest, then the Mandarin for grassland.

You'll want to know: fēngjǐng

fēngjǐng — "scenery; landscape".

> *zhèr de fēngjǐng hěn piàoliang* — The scenery here is beautiful.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēngjǐng is built from 风 'wind' and *jǐng* 'a view', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwng* and *kjaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'bright' and 'light'; the sense 'a view' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēngjǐng*
- *Say it: fēngjǐng*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de fēngjǐng hěn piàoliang* — The scenery here is beautiful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a forest, then the Mandarin for grassland, then say *fēngjǐng* again

Before you move on

What does fēngjǐng mean? ("Scenery; landscape".) Say it once more.

Chapter 227

A Day at the Sea

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell about a day at the seaside: the boat, being seasick, the beach and who I ran into.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 227: I can tell about a day at the seaside: the boat, being seasick, the beach and who I ran into.*

227.1 hǎibiān — the seaside; the seashore

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grassland, then the Mandarin for scenery.

You'll want to know: hǎibiān

hǎibiān — "the seaside; the seashore".

> *shàng ge yuè wǒmen qùle hǎibiān* — Last month we went to the seaside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎibiān is built from *hǎi* 'sea' and 边 'edge', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xojX* and *pen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as the pool of heaven that takes in a hundred rivers.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎibiān*
- *Say it: hǎibiān*, once more
- *Say it: shàng ge yuè wǒmen qùle hǎibiān* — Last month we went to the seaside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grassland, then the Mandarin for scenery, then say *hǎibiān* again

Before you move on

What does hǎibiān mean? ("The seaside; the seashore".) Say it once more.

227.2 chuán — boat; ship

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for scenery, then the Mandarin for the seaside.

You'll want to know: chuán

chuán — "boat; ship".

zuótiān wǒmen zuò chuán le — We went out on a boat yesterday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuán is inherited from Middle Chinese *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which notes, after an older book, that people west of the passes said this word and people east of them another.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuán*
- *Say it: chuán*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān wǒmen zuò chuán le* — We went out on a boat yesterday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for scenery, then the Mandarin for the seaside, then say *chuán* again

Before you move on

What does chuán mean? ("Boat; ship".) Say it once more.

227.3 yùnchuán — to get seasick

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the seaside, then the Mandarin for a boat.

You'll want to know: yùnchuán

yùnchuán — "to get seasick".

wǒ yùnchuán le hěn nánshòu — I got seasick and felt awful.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùnchuán is built from *yùn* 'dizzy' and *chuán* 'boat'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first, *hjunH* there, as a halo round the sun or moon, so how it came to mean dizziness is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùnchuán*
- *Say it: yùnchuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yùnchuán le hěn nánshòu* — I got seasick and felt awful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the seaside, then the Mandarin for a boat, then say *yùnchuán* again

Before you move on

What does yùnchuán mean? ("To get seasick".) Say it once more.

227.4 shātān — sandy beach

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a boat, then the Mandarin for to get seasick.

You'll want to know: shātān

shātān — "sandy beach".

nàr de shātān hěn gānjìng — The beach there was really clean.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shātān is built from *shā* 'sand' and *tān* 'a shore', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srae* and *than* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as stones scattered by water, and glosses the second as shallows in a river, so how it came to mean a beach is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: shātān*
- *Say it: shātān*, once more
- *Say it: nàr de shātān hěn gānjìng* — The beach there was really clean.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a boat, then the Mandarin for to get seasick, then say *shātān* again

Before you move on

What does shātān mean? ("Sandy beach".) Say it once more.

227.5 yùdào — to run into; to come across

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get seasick, then the Mandarin for a sandy beach.

You'll want to know: yùdào

yùdào — "to run into; to come across".

> *zuótiān wǒ yùdàole yí ge lǎo tóngxué* — Yesterday I ran into an old classmate.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùdào is built from *yù* 'to meet by chance' and 到 'to arrive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjuH* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to meet without arranging it'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùdào*
- *Say it: yùdào*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān wǒ yùdàole yí ge lǎo tóngxué* — Yesterday I ran into an old classmate.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get seasick, then the Mandarin for a sandy beach, then say *yùdào* again

Before you move on

What does yùdào mean? ("To run into; to come across".) Say it once more.

Chapter 228

A Headache

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say my head aches, take medicine, have an injection, say whether it is serious, and nod.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 228: I can say my head aches, take medicine, have an injection, say whether it is serious, and nod.*

228.1 头疼 (tóuténg) — having a headache; aching in the head

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sandy beach, then the Mandarin for to run into someone.

You'll want to know: 头疼

头疼 — *tóuténg* — "having a headache; aching in the head".

> 我头疼不想吃饭 *wǒ tóuténg bù xiǎng chīfàn* — I've got a headache, so I don't feel like eating.

The new character, in pieces: 头 — five strokes: two dots, a long bar, a long stroke falling to the left, and a dot at the lower right; 疼 — ten strokes: the illness frame of 病, five strokes, then inside it five more: a short fall to the left, a bar that turns and falls to the left, a long stroke to the right, and two dots. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

头疼 (*tóuténg*) is built from 头 'head' and 疼 'sore', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duw* and *downg* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the head' and the second 'pain'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóuténg*
- *Say it: tóuténg*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ tóuténg bù xiǎng chīfàn* — I've got a headache, so I don't feel like eating.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sandy beach, then the Mandarin for to run into someone, then say *tóuténg* again

Before you move on

What does 头疼 mean? ("Having a headache; aching in the head".) Say it once more.

228.2 头 — two dots over a shape like 大

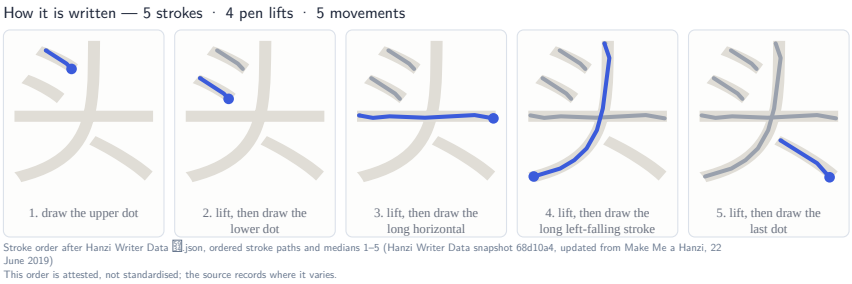
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tóuténg* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  大 天

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *tiān*

Script — two dots over a shape like 大



How 头 is written, stroke by stroke

头

Two pieces: two dots, then a shape like 大.

Two dots, one under the other, each falling to the right, a little left of the middle.

Then three strokes, almost 大: a long bar across, then a long stroke from the top falling down to the left. The last stroke is not the long stroke of 大 but a short dot at the lower right.

2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 头, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 头? (**Five**.) What comes first? (**Two dots**.)
How is the last stroke different from 大? (**It is a short dot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 头, pinned stroke paths and medians.

228.3 疼 — the frame of 病, and a shape of five inside

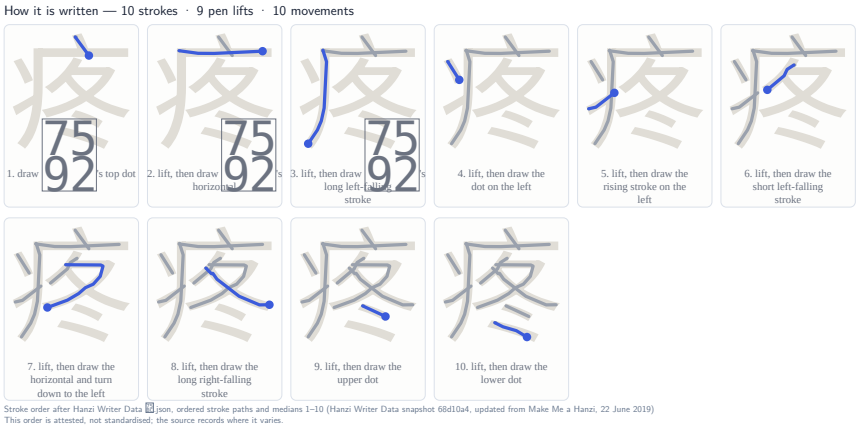
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tóuténg* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  病

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bìng*

Script — the frame of 病, and a shape of five inside



How 疼 is written, stroke by stroke

疼

Two pieces: a frame, and what sits inside it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The frame, five strokes, as in 病: a dot at the top, a bar across, a long stroke falling to the left, then a small dot and a short stroke rising to the right on the far left.

Inside, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A bar that turns and falls to the left. A long stroke falling to the right. Then two dots, one under the other.

5 + 5 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 疼, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 疼? (**Ten**.) Where has your hand made the frame before? (**In** 病.) What comes at the foot? (**Two dots**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 疼, pinned stroke paths and medians.

228.4 chīyào — to take medicine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to run into someone, then the Mandarin for a headache.

You'll want to know: chīyào

chīyào — "to take medicine".

nǐ chīyào le ma — Have you taken your medicine?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chīyào is built from 吃 'to eat' and *yào* 'medicine'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *yak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), explained, after an older book, as a plant that cures illness. The dictionary gives the first, *kj+t* there, only for stammering, so how it came to mean eating is not settled, and chī is not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: chīyào*
- *Say it: chīyào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ chīyào le ma* — Have you taken your medicine?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to run into someone, then the Mandarin for a headache, then say *chīyào* again

Before you move on

What does chīyào mean? ("To take medicine".) Say it once more.

228.5 dǎzhēn — to have an injection; to give one

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a headache, then the Mandarin for to take medicine.

You'll want to know: dǎzhēn

dǎzhēn — "to have an injection; to give one".

wǒ pà dǎzhēn — I'm scared of injections.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎzhēn is built from 打 'to strike, to do' and *zhēn* 'needle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *tsyim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'needle and thread'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎzhēn*
- *Say it: dǎzhēn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ pà dǎzhēn* — I'm scared of injections.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a headache, then the Mandarin for to take medicine, then say *dǎzhēn* again

Before you move on

What does dǎzhēn mean? ("To have an injection; to give one".) Say it once more.

228.6 yánzhòng — serious (of illness); serious (of a problem)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take medicine, then the Mandarin for to have an injection.

You'll want to know: yánzhòng

yánzhòng — "serious (of illness); serious (of a problem)".

yīshēng shuō bù yánzhòng — The doctor says it isn't serious.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yánzhòng is built from *yán* 'stern' and 重 'heavy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjaem* and *drjowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'stern' and 'awe-inspiring'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yánzhòng*
- *Say it: yánzhòng*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng shuō bù yánzhòng* — The doctor says it isn't serious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take medicine, then the Mandarin for to have an injection, then say *yánzhòng* again

Before you move on

What does yánzhòng mean? ("Serious (of illness); serious (of a problem)".) Say it once more.

228.7 点头 (diǎntóu) — to nod

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have an injection, then the Mandarin for serious (of illness).

You'll want to know: 点头

点头 — *diǎntóu* — "to nod".

我问他头疼不疼他点头了 *wǒ wèn tā tóu téng bu téng tā diǎntóu le* — I asked if his head hurt, and he nodded.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

点头 (*diǎntóu*) is built from 点 'to dot' and 头 'head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *temX* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'dots and strokes'; 'to dip' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: diǎntóu*
- *Say it: diǎntóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wèn tā tóu téng bu téng tā diǎntóu le* — I asked if his head hurt, and he nodded.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have an injection, then the Mandarin for serious (of illness), then say *diǎntóu* again

Before you move on

What does 点头 mean? ("To nod".) Say it once more.

Chapter 229

Keeping a Pet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about pets: keeping one, walking the dog, being scratched and stroking them.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 229: I can talk about pets: keeping one, walking the dog, being scratched and stroking them.*

229.1 chǒngwù — pet

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for serious (of illness), then the Mandarin for to nod.

You'll want to know: chǒngwù

chǒngwù — "pet".

> *nǐ jiā yǒu chǒngwù ma* — Have you got a pet at home?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǒngwù is built from *chǒng* 'to dote on' and *wù* 'thing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trhjowngX* and *mjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to love and favour'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǒngwù*
- *Say it: chǒngwù*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ jiā yǒu chǒngwù ma* — Have you got a pet at home?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for serious (of illness), then the Mandarin for to nod, then say *chǒngwù* again

Before you move on

What does chǒngwù mean? ("Pet".) Say it once more.

229.2 yǎng — to keep an animal; to raise

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to nod, then the Mandarin for a pet.

You'll want to know: yǎng

yǎng — "to keep an animal; to raise".

wǒ xiǎng yǎng yì zhī māo — I'd like to have a cat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎng is inherited from Middle Chinese *yangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to rear' and 'to delight'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎng*
- *Say it: yǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng yǎng yì zhī māo* — I'd like to have a cat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to nod, then the Mandarin for a pet, then say *yǎng* again

Before you move on

What does yǎng mean? ("To keep an animal; to raise".) Say it once more.

229.3 liùgǒu — to walk the dog

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pet, then the Mandarin for to keep an animal.

You'll want to know: liùgǒu

liùgǒu — "to walk the dog".

wǒ měitiān wǎnshang liùgǒu — I walk the dog every evening.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liùgǒu is built from *liù* 'to stroll' and *gǒu* 'dog'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *kuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'dog'; the dictionary glosses the first, *ljuw* there, 'to linger', and the falling tone of liù is not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: liùgǒu*
- *Say it: liùgǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān wǎnshang liùgǒu* — I walk the dog every evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pet, then the Mandarin for to keep an animal, then say *liùgǒu* again

Before you move on

What does liùgǒu mean? ("To walk the dog".) Say it once more.

229.4 zhuā — to scratch; to grab

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep an animal, then the Mandarin for to walk the dog.

You'll want to know: zhuā

zhuā — "to scratch; to grab".

bié pà wǒ de māo bù zhuā rén — Don't worry, my cat doesn't scratch.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuā is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsraew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to scratch and pinch'; the vowel of zhuā is not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuā*
- *Say it: zhuā*, once more
- *Say it: bié pà wǒ de māo bù zhuā rén* — Don't worry, my cat doesn't scratch.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep an animal, then the Mandarin for to walk the dog, then say *zhuā* again

Before you move on

What does zhuā mean? ("To scratch; to grab".) Say it once more.

229.5 mō — to stroke; to touch

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to walk the dog, then the Mandarin for to scratch.

You'll want to know: mō

mō — "to stroke; to touch".

wǒ kěyǐ mō nǐ de gǒu ma — Can I stroke your dog?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mō is inherited from Middle Chinese *mu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to feel with the hand'. The vowel and the level tone of mō are not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mō*
- *Say it:* *mō*, once more
- *Say it:* *wǒ kěyǐ mō nǐ de gǒu ma* — Can I stroke your dog?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to walk the dog, then the Mandarin for to scratch, then say *mō* again

Before you move on

What does mō mean? ("To stroke; to touch".) Say it once more.

229.6 Looking back: from Spring Flowers to Keeping a Pet

Say the Mandarin for to bloom and a florist's.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to bloom, a florist's, a garden, a butterfly, a bee
- *Say it:* the countryside, a farmer, to work the land, to pick fruit, to camp out
- *Say it:* a lawn, a lake, a forest, grassland, scenery
- *Say it:* the seaside, a boat, to get seasick, a sandy beach, to run into someone
- *Say it:* a headache, to take medicine, to have an injection, serious (of illness), to nod
- *Say it:* a pet, to keep an animal, to walk the dog, to scratch, to stroke
- *Read it:* 花 草 头 疼 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To bloom? (开花, *kāihuā*.) A florist's? (花店, *huādiàn*.) A garden? (*huāyuán*.) A butterfly? (*húdié*.) A bee? (*mìfēng*.) The

countryside? (*nóngcūn.*) A farmer? (*nóngmín.*) To work the land? (*zhòngdì.*) To pick fruit? (*zhāi.*) To camp out? (*lùyíng.*) A lawn? (草地, *cǎodì.*) A lake? (*hú.*) A forest? (*sēnlín.*) Grassland? (*cǎoyuán.*) Scenery? (*fēngjǐng.*) The seaside? (*hǎibiān.*) A boat? (*chuán.*) To get seasick? (*yùnchuán.*) A sandy beach? (*shātān.*) To run into someone? (*yùdào.*) A headache? (头疼, *tóuténg.*) To take medicine? (*chīyào.*) To have an injection? (*dǎzhēn.*) Serious (of illness)? (*yánzhòng.*) To nod? (点头, *diǎntóu.*) A pet? (*chǒngwù.*) To keep an animal? (*yǎng.*) To walk the dog? (*liùgǒu.*) To scratch? (*zhuā.*) To stroke? (*mō.*)

Chapter 230

Head to Toe

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I have on me and what I weigh, and talk about my tummy, my nose and my legs.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 230: I can say what I have on me and what I weigh, and talk about my tummy, my nose and my legs.*

230.1 身上 (shēnshang) — on your person; on one's body

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to scratch, then the Mandarin for to stroke.

You'll want to know: 身上

身上 — *shēnshang* — "on your person; on one's body".

> 我身上没有钱 *wǒ shēnshang méiyǒu qián* — I haven't got any money on me.

The new character, in pieces: 身 — seven strokes: a short fall to the left, a short vertical, a bar that turns down into a long hook, two short bars inside, a long stroke rising to the right, and a long stroke falling to the left. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

身上 (*shēnshang*) is built from 身 'body' and 上 'on', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syin* and *dzyangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'oneself' and 'the body'; in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnshang*
- *Say it: shēnshang*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shēnshang méiyǒu qián* — I haven't got any money on me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to scratch, then the Mandarin for to stroke, then say *shēnshang* again

Before you move on

What does 身上 mean? ("On your person; on one's body".) Say it once more.

230.2 身 — a frame with two bars, crossed by two long strokes

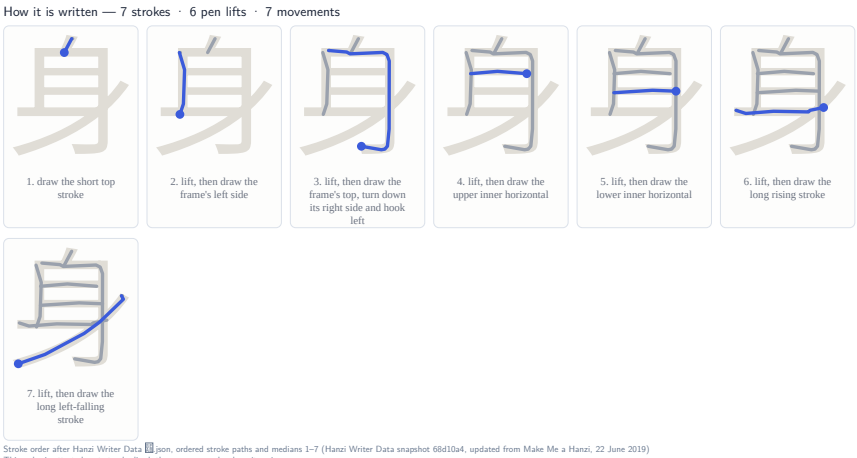
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shēnshang* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  上 月

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shàng*, *yuè*

Script — a frame with two bars, crossed by two long strokes



How 身 is written, stroke by stroke

身

One piece, seven strokes. Count them in three groups.

The frame, three strokes. A short stroke falling to the left at the top. A short vertical on the left. Then a bar from its top that runs right and turns down into a long stroke to the foot, hooking left.

Inside, two short bars, one under the other.

Across it all, two long strokes. A stroke rising from the far left to the right, through the frame. Then a long stroke from the upper right falling down to the lower left.

3 + 2 + 2 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 身, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 身? (**Seven**.) How many short bars sit inside the frame? (**Two**.) What comes last? (**The long stroke falling to the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 身, pinned stroke paths and medians.

230.3 体重 (tǐzhòng) — body weight

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stroke, then the Mandarin for on your person.

You'll want to know: 体重

体重 — *tǐzhòng* — "body weight".

你的体重是多少 *nǐ de tǐzhòng shì duōshao* — How much do you weigh?

The new character, in pieces: 体 — seven strokes: the person piece 亻, then 本. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

体重 (*tǐzhòng*) is built from 体 'body' and 重 'heavy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *drjowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the body' and the second 'much' and 'thick'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐzhòng*
- *Say it: tǐzhòng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de tǐzhòng shì duōshao* — How much do you weigh?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stroke, then the Mandarin for on your person, then say *tǐzhòng* again

Before you move on

What does 体重 mean? (“Body weight”.) Say it once more.

230.4 体 — the person piece, then 本

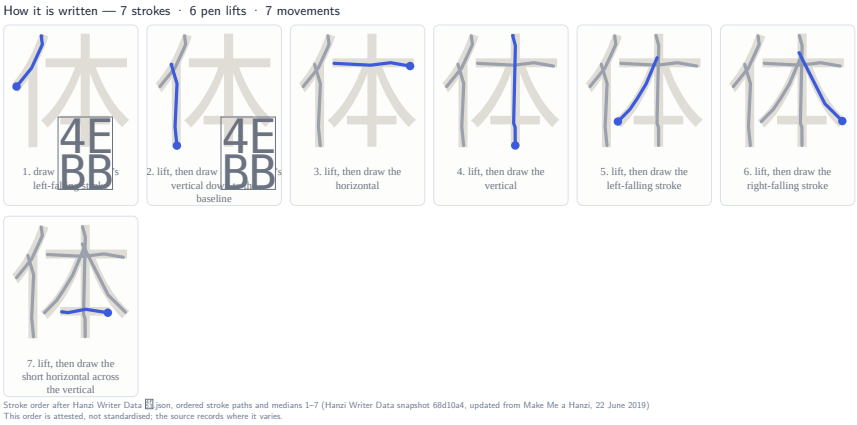
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tǐzhòng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  本 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *běn*, *nǐ*

Script — the person piece, then 本



How 体 *is written, stroke by stroke*

体

Two pieces, left before right.
The person piece, 亻, two strokes, as in 你 and 他.
Then 本, five strokes, as in 本子: a bar across, a long vertical, a stroke falling to the left and one falling to the right, then a short bar low on the vertical.
2 + 5 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 体, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 体? (**Seven.**) What are its two pieces? (亻 **and** 本.) What comes last? (**The short bar near the foot.**) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 体, pinned stroke paths and medians.

230.5 dùzi — belly; tummy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for on your person, then the Mandarin for body weight.

You'll want to know: dùzi

dùzi — "belly; tummy".

wǒ dùzi téng — My tummy hurts.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dùzi is built from *dù* 'belly' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duX* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the belly'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: dùzi*
- *Say it: dùzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dùzi téng* — My tummy hurts.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for on your person, then the Mandarin for body weight, then say *dùzi* again

Before you move on

What does dùzi mean? ("Belly; tummy".) Say it once more.

230.6 bízi — nose

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for body weight, then the Mandarin for a tummy.

You'll want to know: bízi

bízi — "nose".

tā de bízi hěn gāo — He has a high-bridged nose.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bízi is built from *bí* 'nose' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjijH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as drawing in breath. It is listed with a departing tone, so the rising tone of bí is not the regular outcome.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: bízi*
- *Say it: bízi*, once more
- *Say it: tā de bízi hěn gāo* — He has a high-bridged nose.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for body weight, then the Mandarin for a tummy, then say *bízi* again

Before you move on

What does bízi mean? (“Nose”.) Say it once more.

230.7 tuǐ — leg

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tummy, then the Mandarin for a nose.

You’ll want to know: tuǐ

tuǐ — “leg”.

wǒ shēnshang téng tuǐ yě téng — I ache all over, and my legs too.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuǐ is inherited from Middle Chinese *thwojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’the thigh’; the dictionary lists the character as the everyday form of another.

What you’ve built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuǐ*
- *Say it: tuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shēnshang téng tuǐ yě téng* — I ache all over, and my legs too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tummy, then the Mandarin for a nose, then say *tuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does tuǐ mean? (“Leg”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 231

Seeing a Doctor

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can choose Chinese or Western medicine, register at the clinic, talk about the nurse and say what the doctor gave me.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 231: I can choose Chinese or Western medicine, register at the clinic, talk about the nurse and say what the doctor gave me.*

231.1 中医 (zhōngyī) — traditional Chinese medicine; a doctor of it

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a nose, then the Mandarin for a leg.

You'll want to know: 中医

中医 — *zhōngyī* — "traditional Chinese medicine; a doctor of it".

> 我想看中医 *wǒ xiǎng kàn zhōngyī* — I'd like to see a Chinese-medicine doctor.

The new character, in pieces: 医 — seven strokes: a bar on top, five strokes inside it (a short fall, a short bar, a long bar, a long fall and a dot), then a stroke down the left that turns right along the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中医 (*zhōngyī*) is built from 中, as in 中国, and 医 'medicine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *'i* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to heal'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōngyī*
- *Say it: zhōngyī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng kàn zhōngyī* — I'd like to see a Chinese-medicine doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a nose, then the Mandarin for a leg, then say *zhōngyī* again

Before you move on

What does 中医 mean? ("Traditional Chinese medicine; a doctor of it".) Say it once more.

231.2 医 — a box open on the right, with five strokes inside

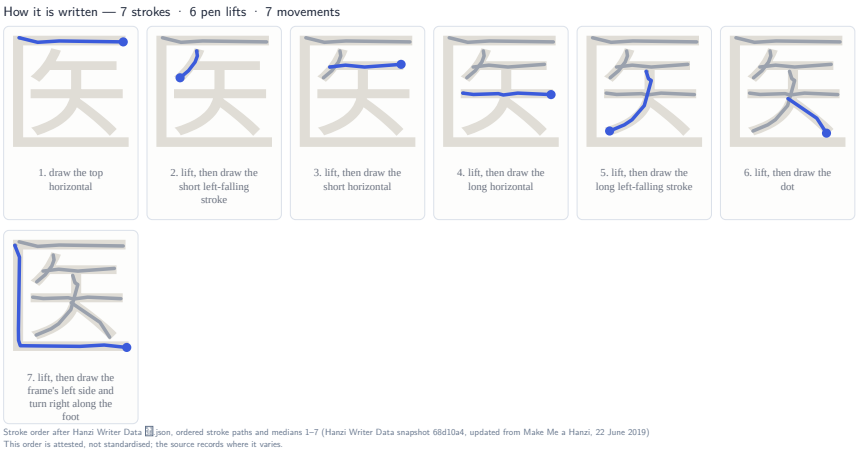
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhōngyī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  头 中

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tóu*, *zhōng*

Script — a box open on the right, with five strokes inside



How 医 *is written, stroke by stroke*

医

Two pieces: a box open on the right, and what sits inside. The box takes two strokes, one first and one last.

First, the top bar of the box.

Inside, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left, then a short bar. Then three as at the foot of 头: a long bar, a long stroke falling to the left through it, and a dot falling to the right.

Last, the box closes: a vertical down the left that turns and runs right along the foot.

1 + 5 + 1 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 医, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 医? (**Seven.**) Which stroke comes last? (**The one down the left and along the foot.**) How many strokes sit

inside? (**Five**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 医, pinned stroke paths and medians.

231.3 西医 (xīyī) — western medicine; a doctor of it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a leg, then the Mandarin for Chinese medicine.

You'll want to know: 西医

西医 — *xīyī* — "western medicine; a doctor of it".

我身体不好头也疼想看西医 *wǒ shēntǐ bù hǎo tóu yě téng xiǎng kàn xīyī* — I'm not well and my head hurts too; I'd like to see a doctor of western medicine.

The new character, in pieces: 西 — six strokes: a bar on top, a box of two strokes, two strokes inside it that start above it, and a bar along the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

西医 (*xīyī*) is built from 西 'west' and 医 'medicine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sej* and *ʔi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as a bird settling on its nest when the sun is in the west.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīyī*
- *Say it: xīyī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shēntǐ bù hǎo tóu yě téng xiǎng kàn xīyī* — I'm not well and my head hurts too; I'd like to see a doctor of western medicine.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a leg, then the Mandarin for Chinese medicine, then say *xīyī* again

Before you move on

What does 西医 mean? ("Western medicine; a doctor of it".) Say it once more.

231.4 西 — a bar, a box and two strokes inside

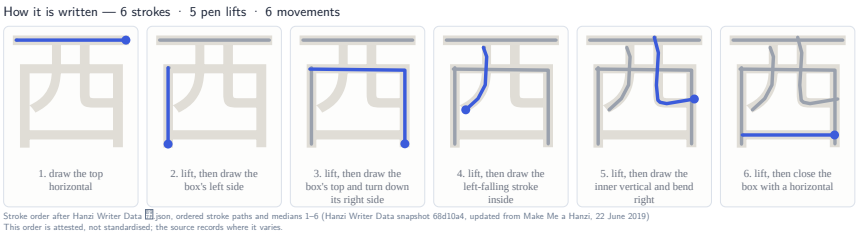
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xīyī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  要 票

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yào*, *piào*

Script — a bar, a box and two strokes inside



How 西 *is written, stroke by stroke*

西

One piece, six strokes.
A bar across the top.
The box, two strokes: a vertical down the whole left side, then a bar that runs right and turns down.
Inside, two strokes, each starting above the box: a stroke down that falls a little to the left, then a stroke down that turns right along the inside.
Last, a bar closes the foot.
1 + 2 + 2 + 1 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 西, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 西? (**Six**.) Where do the two inner strokes start? (**Above the box**.) What comes last? (**The bar along the foot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 西, pinned stroke paths and medians.

231.5 guàhào — to register at a clinic; to register at a hospital

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for Chinese medicine, then the Mandarin for western medicine.

You'll want to know: guàhào

guàhào — "to register at a clinic; to register at a hospital".

kànbìng yǐqián yào guàhào — Before you see the doctor, you have to register.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guàhào is built from *guà* 'to hang up' and 号 'a number', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kweaH* and *hawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: guàhào*
- *Say it: guàhào*, once more
- *Say it: kànbìng yǐqián yào guàhào* — Before you see the doctor, you have to register.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for Chinese medicine, then the Mandarin for western medicine, then say *guàhào* again

Before you move on

What does guàhào mean? ("To register at a clinic; to register at a hospital".) Say it once more.

231.6 hùshi — nurse

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for western medicine, then the Mandarin for to register at a clinic.

You'll want to know: hùshi

hùshi — "nurse".

tā shì zhèr de hùshi — She's a nurse here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hùshi is built from *hù* 'to protect' and *shi* 'a scholar', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huH* and *dzriX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to save' and 'to help'; in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: hùshi*
- *Say it: hùshi*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì zhèr de hùshi* — She's a nurse here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for western medicine, then the Mandarin for to register at a clinic, then say *hùshi* again

Before you move on

What does hùshi mean? ("Nurse".) Say it once more.

231.7 kāiyào — to prescribe medicine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to register at a clinic, then the Mandarin for a nurse.

You'll want to know: kāiyào

kāiyào — "to prescribe medicine".

zhōngyī yě huì kāiyào — Chinese-medicine doctors prescribe medicine too.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāiyào is built from 开 'to open' and *yào* 'medicine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *yak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the sense 'to write out a prescription' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāiyào*
- *Say it: kāiyào*, once more
- *Say it: zhōngyī yě huì kāiyào* — Chinese-medicine doctors prescribe medicine too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to register at a clinic, then the Mandarin for a nurse, then say *kāiyào* again

Before you move on

What does kāiyào mean? ("To prescribe medicine".) Say it once more.

Chapter 232

An Accident

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell what happened in an accident: who got hurt, who was bleeding, what crashed and the ambulance.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 232: I can tell what happened in an accident: who got hurt, who was bleeding, what crashed and the ambulance.*

232.1 出事 (chūshì) — to have an accident; for something to go wrong

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a nurse, then the Mandarin for to prescribe.

You'll want to know: 出事

出事 — *chūshì* — "to have an accident; for something to go wrong".

> 前天雪很大这儿出事了 *qiántiān xuě hěn dà zhèr chūshì le* — The day before yesterday the snow was heavy, and there was an accident here.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出事 (*chūshì*) is built from 出 'to come out' and 事 'a matter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to employ' and 'to set up'; 'a matter' is the everyday sense, not the gloss.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūshì*
- *Say it: chūshì*, once more
- *Say it: qiántiān xuě hěn dà zhèr chūshì le* — The day before yesterday the snow was heavy, and there was an accident here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a nurse, then the Mandarin for to prescribe, then say *chūshì* again

Before you move on

What does 出事 mean? ("To have an accident; for something to go wrong".) Say it once more.

232.2 shòushāng — to get hurt; to be injured

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to prescribe, then the Mandarin for to have an accident.

You'll want to know: shòushāng

shòushāng — "to get hurt; to be injured".

tā de tuǐ shòushāng le — He hurt his leg.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shòushāng is built from *shòu* 'to receive' and *shāng* 'a wound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyuwX* and *syang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to receive' and the

second 'harm'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: shòushāng*
- *Say it: shòushāng*, once more
- *Say it: tā de tuǐ shòushāng le* — He hurt his leg.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to prescribe, then the Mandarin for to have an accident, then say *shòushāng* again

Before you move on

What does shòushāng mean? ("To get hurt; to be injured".) Say it once more.

232.3 liúxuè — to bleed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have an accident, then the Mandarin for to get hurt.

You'll want to know: liúxuè

liúxuè — "to bleed".

nǐ de shǒu liúxuè le — Your hand's bleeding.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúxuè is built from *liú* 'to flow' and *xuè* 'blood', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *xwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as water moving.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúxuè*
- *Say it: liúxuè*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de shǒu liúxuè le* — Your hand's bleeding.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have an accident, then the Mandarin for to get hurt, then say *liúxuè* again

Before you move on

What does liúxuè mean? ("To bleed".) Say it once more.

232.4 zhuàng — to crash into; to bump into

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get hurt, then the Mandarin for to bleed.

You'll want to know: zhuàng

zhuàng — "to crash into; to bump into".

tā qí chē zhuàngdàole yí ge rén — He rode his bike into someone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuàng is inherited from Middle Chinese *draewngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to strike a bell'; the dictionary glosses its other reading 'to knock against'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuàng*
- *Say it: zhuàng*, once more
- *Say it: tā qí chē zhuàngdàole yí ge rén* — He rode his bike into someone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get hurt, then the Mandarin for to bleed, then say *zhuàng* again

Before you move on

What does zhuàng mean? ("To crash into; to bump into".) Say it once more.

232.5 jiùhùchē — ambulance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to bleed, then the Mandarin for to crash into.

You'll want to know: jiùhùchē

jiùhùchē — "ambulance".

gǎnkuài jiào jiùhùchē — Call an ambulance, quick!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiùhùchē is built from *jiù* 'to rescue', *hù* 'to protect' and 车 'vehicle', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjuwH*, *huH* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to protect' and 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiùhùchē*
- *Say it: jiùhùchē*, once more
- *Say it: gǎnkuài jiào jiùhùchē* — Call an ambulance, quick!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to bleed, then the Mandarin for to crash into, then say *jiùhùchē* again

Before you move on

What does jiùhùchē mean? ("Ambulance".) Say it once more.

Chapter 233

How People Look

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe someone's appearance: their glasses, a beard, a slim figure and their skin.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 233: I can describe someone's appearance: their glasses, a beard, a slim figure and their skin.*

233.1 yàngzi — appearance; manner

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to crash into, then the Mandarin for an ambulance.

You'll want to know: yàngzi

yàngzi — "appearance; manner".

> *tā de yàngzi hěn xiàng tā bàba* — He takes after his dad.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yàngzi is built from *yàng* 'shape' and the noun ending 子, inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàngzi*
- *Say it: yàngzi*, once more
- *Say it: tā de yàngzi hěn xiàng tā bàba* — He takes after his dad.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to crash into, then the Mandarin for an ambulance, then say *yàngzi* again

Before you move on

What does yàngzi mean? ("Appearance; manner".) Say it once more.

233.2 yǎnjìng — glasses; spectacles

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an ambulance, then the Mandarin for appearance.

You'll want to know: yǎnjìng

yǎnjìng — "glasses; spectacles".

wǒ de yǎnjìng ne — Where are my glasses?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎnjìng is built from *yǎn* 'eye' and *jìng* 'mirror', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngeanX* and *kjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the eye'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnjìng*
- *Say it: yǎnjìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de yǎnjìng ne* — Where are my glasses?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an ambulance, then the Mandarin for appearance, then say *yǎnjìng* again

Before you move on

What does yǎnjìng mean? ("Glasses; spectacles".) Say it once more.

233.3 húzi — beard; moustache

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for appearance, then the Mandarin for glasses for the eyes.

You'll want to know: húzi

húzi — "beard; moustache".

wǒ bàba yǒu húzi — My dad has a beard.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

húzi is built from *hú* 'beard' and the noun ending 子, inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: húzi*
- *Say it: húzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba yǒu húzi* — My dad has a beard.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for appearance, then the Mandarin for glasses for the eyes, then say *húzi* again

Before you move on

What does húzi mean? ("Beard; moustache".) Say it once more.

233.4 miáotiao — slim; slender

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for glasses for the eyes, then the Mandarin for a beard.

You'll want to know: miáotiao

miáotiao — "slim; slender".

tā hěn miáotiao — She's very slender.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

miáotiao is built from *miáo* 'a sprout' and *tiáo* 'a twig'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a small branch'; the dictionary glosses the first, *mjew* there, 'young crops in the field'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: miáotiao*
- *Say it: miáotiao*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn miáotiao* — She's very slender.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for glasses for the eyes, then the Mandarin for a beard, then say *miáotiao* again

Before you move on

What does miáotiao mean? ("Slim; slender".) Say it once more.

233.5 pífū — skin

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a beard, then the Mandarin for slender.

You'll want to know: pífū

pífū — "skin".

tā de pífū hěn bái — She has very fair skin.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pífū is built from *pí* 'hide' and *fū* 'skin'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *bje* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed with this very word, 'skin'; the dictionary glosses the second, *pju* there, the same way.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: pífū*
- *Say it: pífū*, once more
- *Say it: tā de pífū hěn bái* — She has very fair skin.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a beard, then the Mandarin for slender, then say *pífū* again

Before you move on

What does pífū mean? ("Skin".) Say it once more.

Chapter 234

Rain or Shine

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can put plans off, call them off, move them to another day, take a raincoat and shelter from the rain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 234: I can put plans off, call them off, move them to another day, take a raincoat and shelter from the rain.*

234.1 tuīchí — to put off; to postpone

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for slender, then the Mandarin for skin.

You'll want to know: tuīchí

tuīchí — "to put off; to postpone".

> *míngtiān xiàyǔ wǒmen de yěcān yào tuīchí* — It's going to rain tomorrow, so our picnic will have to wait.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuīchí is built from *tuī* 'to push' and *chí* 'slow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwoj* and *drij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'slow' and 'leisurely'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuīchí*
- *Say it: tuīchí*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān xiàyǔ wǒmen de yěcān yào tuīchí* — It's going to rain tomorrow, so our picnic will have to wait.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for slender, then the Mandarin for skin, then say *tuīchí* again

Before you move on

What does tuīchí mean? ("To put off; to postpone".) Say it once more.

234.2 qǔxiāo — to cancel; to call off

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for skin, then the Mandarin for to put off.

You'll want to know: qǔxiāo

qǔxiāo — "to cancel; to call off".

xiàyǔ le bǐsài qǔxiāo le — It's raining, so the match is off.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qǔxiāo is built from *qǔ* 'to take' and *xiāo* 'to melt away', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjuX* and *sjew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to take in' and the second 'to wipe out' and 'to use up'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǔxiāo*
- *Say it: qǔxiāo*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ le bǐsài qǔxiāo le* — It's raining, so the match is off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for skin, then the Mandarin for to put off, then say *qǔxiāo* again

Before you move on

What does qǔxiāo mean? ("To cancel; to call off".) Say it once more.

234.3 gǎitiān — some other day; another time

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put off, then the Mandarin for to call off.

You'll want to know: gǎitiān

gǎitiān — "some other day; another time".

jīntiān xiàyǔ wǒmen gǎitiān qù — It's raining today; let's go another day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎitiān is built from *gǎi* 'to change' and 天 'day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to alter'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎitiān*
- *Say it: gǎitiān*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān xiàyǔ wǒmen gǎitiān qù* — It's raining today; let's go another day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put off, then the Mandarin for to call off, then say *gǎitiān* again

Before you move on

What does gǎitiān mean? ("Some other day; another time".) Say it once more.

234.4 雨衣 (yǔyī) — raincoat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to call off, then the Mandarin for some other day.

You'll want to know: 雨衣

雨衣 — *yǔyī* — "raincoat".

下雨了风也很大我有雨衣 *xiàyǔ le fēng yě hěn dà wǒ yǒu yǔyī* — It's raining and it's windy too; good thing I've got a raincoat.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

雨衣 (*yǔyī*) is built from 雨 'rain' and 衣 'garment', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuX* and *'j+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǔyī*
- *Say it: yǔyī*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ le fēng yě hěn dà wǒ yǒu yǔyī* — It's raining and it's windy too; good thing I've got a raincoat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to call off, then the Mandarin for some other day, then say *yǔyī* again

Before you move on

What does 雨衣 mean? ("Raincoat".) Say it once more.

234.5 duǒyǔ — to shelter from the rain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for some other day, then the Mandarin for a raincoat.

You'll want to know: duǒyǔ

duǒyǔ — "to shelter from the rain".

xiàyǔ le wǒmen qù fàndiàn duǒyǔ — It started raining, so we sheltered in a restaurant.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Tone: duǒ and yǔ are both third tones, so the first rises and it sounds like duóyǔ.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duǒyǔ is built from *duǒ* 'to hide' and 雨 'rain'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: duǒyǔ*
- *Say it: duǒyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ le wǒmen qù fàndiàn duǒyǔ* — It started raining, so we sheltered in a restaurant.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for some other day, then the Mandarin for a raincoat, then say *duǒyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does duǒyǔ mean? ("To shelter from the rain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 235

For a Reason

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give reasons and purposes: what I do it for, what caused it, my grounds, what I had to do, and no wonder.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 235: I can give reasons and purposes: what I do it for, what caused it, my grounds, what I had to do, and no wonder.*

235.1 为了 (wèile) — for; in order to

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a raincoat, then the Mandarin for to shelter from the rain.

You'll want to know: 为了

为了 — *wèile* — "for; in order to".

> 为了身体我们都不吃点心了 *wèile shēntǐ wǒmen dōu bù chī diǎnxin le* — For our health, we've all given up snacks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

为了 (*wèile*) is built from 为 'for' and 了, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjweH* and *lewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to help'; in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wèile*
- *Say it: wèile*, once more
- *Say it: wèile shēntǐ wǒmen dōu bù chī diǎnxin le* — For our health, we've all given up snacks.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a raincoat, then the Mandarin for to shelter from the rain, then say *wèile* again

Before you move on

What does 为了 mean? ("For; in order to".) Say it once more.

235.2 yóuyú — owing to; because of

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shelter from the rain, then the Mandarin for in order to.

You'll want to know: yóuyú

yóuyú — "owing to; because of".

yóuyú tiānqì bù hǎo wǒmen méi qù hǎibiān — Because of the bad weather, we didn't go to the seaside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóuyú is built from *yóu* 'from' and *yú* 'at', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *'jo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to follow' and 'by way of', and the second 'to dwell' and lists it as a particle.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóuyú*
- *Say it: yóuyú*, once more
- *Say it: yóuyú tiānqì bù hǎo wǒmen méi qù hǎibiān* — Because of the bad weather, we didn't go to the seaside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shelter from the rain, then the Mandarin for in order to, then say *yóuyú* again

Before you move on

What does yóuyú mean? ("Owing to; because of".) Say it once more.

235.3 lǐyóu — reason; grounds

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in order to, then the Mandarin for owing to.

You'll want to know: lǐyóu

lǐyóu — "reason; grounds".

nǐ yǒu shénme lǐyóu — What are your grounds?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǐyóu is built from *lǐ* 'reason' and *yóu* 'cause', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *liX* and *yuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to put in order' and explains it, after an older book, as working jade.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐyóu*
- *Say it: lǐyóu*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu shénme lǐyóu* — What are your grounds?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in order to, then the Mandarin for owing to, then say *lǐyóu* again

Before you move on

What does lǐyóu mean? ("Reason; grounds".) Say it once more.

235.4 zhǐhǎo — to have no choice but to

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for owing to, then the Mandarin for grounds for doing something.

You'll want to know: zhǐhǎo

zhǐhǎo — "to have no choice but to".

méiyǒu chē le wǒmen zhǐhǎo zǒulù — There was no transport left, so we had to walk.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Tone: zhǐ and hǎo are both third tones, so the first rises and it sounds like zhíhǎo.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǐhǎo is built from *zhǐ* 'only' and 好 'good'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the first, *tsyeX* there, as a particle.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǐhǎo*
- *Say it: zhǐhǎo*, once more
- *Say it: méiyǒu chē le wǒmen zhǐhǎo zǒulù* — There was no transport left, so we had to walk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for owing to, then the Mandarin for grounds for doing something, then say *zhǐhǎo* again

Before you move on

What does zhǐhǎo mean? ("To have no choice but to".) Say it once more.

235.5 guàibude — no wonder

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grounds for doing something, then the Mandarin for to have no choice but.

You'll want to know: guàibude

guàibude — "no wonder".

tā gǎnmào le guàibude tā méi lái — He's got a cold; no wonder he didn't come.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Tone: 不 is light here, bu, with no tone of its own.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guàibude is built from *guài* 'to find strange', 不 'not' and 得 'can', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *kweajH*, *pjut* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'strange'; in the word the last two lose their tones.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: guàibude*
- *Say it: guàibude*, once more
- *Say it: tā gǎnmào le guàibude tā méi lái* — He's got a cold; no wonder he didn't come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grounds for doing something, then the Mandarin for to have no choice but, then say *guàibude* again

Before you move on

What does guàibude mean? ("No wonder".) Say it once more.

235.6 Looking back: from Head to Toe to For a Reason

Say the Mandarin for on your person and body weight.

Your turn

- *Say it:* on your person, body weight, a tummy, a nose, a leg
- *Say it:* Chinese medicine, western medicine, to register at a clinic, a nurse, to prescribe
- *Say it:* to have an accident, to get hurt, to bleed, to crash into, an ambulance
- *Say it:* appearance, glasses for the eyes, a beard, slender, skin
- *Say it:* to put off, to call off, some other day, a raincoat, to shelter from the rain
- *Say it:* in order to, owing to, grounds for doing something, to have no choice but, no wonder
- *Read it:* 身 体 医 西 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

On your person? (身上, *shēnshang.*) Body weight? (体重, *tǐzhòng.*) A tummy? (*dùzi.*) A nose? (*bízi.*) A leg? (*tuǐ.*) Chinese medicine? (中医, *zhōngyī.*) Western medicine? (西医, *xīyī.*) To register at a clinic? (*guàhào.*) A nurse? (*hùshi.*) To prescribe? (*kāiyào.*) To have an accident? (出事, *chūshì.*) To get hurt? (*shòushāng.*) To bleed? (*liúxuè.*) To crash into? (*zhuàng.*) An ambulance? (*jiùhùchē.*) Appearance? (*yàngzi.*) Glasses for the eyes? (*yǎnjìng.*) A beard? (*húzi.*) Slender? (*miáotiao.*) Skin? (*pífū.*) To put off? (*tuīchí.*) To call off? (*qǔxiāo.*) Some other day? (*gǎitiān.*) A raincoat? (雨衣, *yǔyī.*) To shelter from the rain? (*duǒyǔ.*) In order to? (为了, *wèile.*) Owing to? (*yóuyú.*) Grounds for doing something? (*lǐyóu.*) To have no choice but? (*zhǐhǎo.*) No wonder? (*guàibude.*)

Chapter 236

Something Odd

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say something turned up, someone found out, how scared I was, what luckily happened and what nearly did.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 236: I can say something turned up, someone found out, how scared I was, what luckily happened and what nearly did.*

236.1 出现 (chūxiàn) — to appear; to turn up

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have no choice but, then the Mandarin for no wonder.

You'll want to know: 出现

出现 — *chūxiàn* — "to appear; to turn up".

> 草地里出现了一个人 *cǎodì lǐ chūxiànle yí ge rén* — Someone appeared on the lawn.

The new character, in pieces: 现 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left two bars, a vertical and a stroke rising to the right, then 见 on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出现 (*chūxiàn*) is built from 出 'to come out' and 现 'to show', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *henH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to reveal', noting the character as an everyday form.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūxiàn*
- *Say it: chūxiàn*, once more
- *Say it: cǎodì lǐ chūxiànle yí ge rén* — Someone appeared on the lawn.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have no choice but, then the Mandarin for no wonder, then say *chūxiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 出现 mean? ("To appear; to turn up".) Say it once more.

236.2 现 — a narrow left piece, then 见

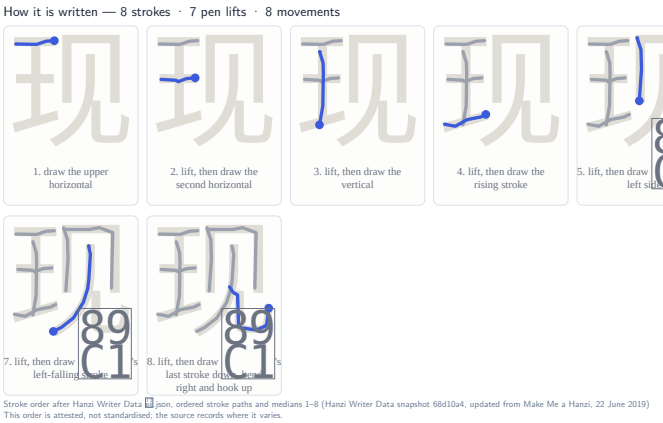
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chūxiàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  见 在

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jiàn*, *zài*

Script — a narrow left piece, then 见



How 现 *is written, stroke by stroke*

现

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, four strokes, narrow: a bar, a second bar, a vertical down through both, then a short stroke rising to the right at the foot.

The right piece, 见, four strokes, as in 再见 and 看见: a vertical, a bar that runs right and turns down, a long stroke falling to the left, then a stroke that bends right along the foot and flicks up.

4 + 4 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 现, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 现? (**Eight**.) What is the right piece? (见.) Which way does the last stroke of the left piece go? (**It rises to the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 现, pinned stroke paths and medians.

236.3 fāxiàn — to discover; to find out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for no wonder, then the Mandarin for to turn up.

You'll want to know: fāxiàn

fāxiàn — "to discover; to find out".

huí jiā yǐhòu wǒ fāxiàn qiánbāo diū le — When I got home, I found my wallet was gone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāxiàn is built from *fā* 'to send out' and 现 'to show', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *henH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and 'to make clear'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāxiàn*
- *Say it: fāxiàn*, once more
- *Say it: huí jiā yǐhòu wǒ fāxiàn qiánbāo diū le* — When I got home, I found my wallet was gone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for no wonder, then the Mandarin for to turn up, then say *fāxiàn* again

Before you move on

What does fāxiàn mean? ("To discover; to find out".) Say it once more.

236.4 hàipà — to be scared

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn up, then the Mandarin for to find out.

You'll want to know: hàipà

hàipà — "to be scared".

wǎnshang yí ge rén zài jiā wǒ hěn hàipà — Home alone at night, I was really scared.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hàipà is built from *hài* 'harm' and *pà* 'to fear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hajH* and *phaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to injure'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: hàipà*
- *Say it: hàipà*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang yí ge rén zài jiā wǒ hěn hàipà* — Home alone at night, I was really scared.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn up, then the Mandarin for to find out, then say *hàipà* again

Before you move on

What does hàipà mean? ("To be scared".) Say it once more.

236.5 xìnghǎo — luckily; fortunately

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to find out, then the Mandarin for to be scared.

You'll want to know: xìnghǎo

xìnghǎo — "luckily; fortunately".

> *xìnghǎo nǐ lái le* — Thank goodness you came.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìnghǎo is built from *xìng* 'fortunate' and 好 'good', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *heangX* and *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as getting the good and escaping the bad.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìnghǎo*
- *Say it: xìnghǎo*, once more
- *Say it: xìnghǎo nǐ lái le* — Thank goodness you came.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to find out, then the Mandarin for to be scared, then say *xìnghǎo* again

Before you move on

What does xìnghǎo mean? ("Luckily; fortunately".) Say it once more.

236.6 chàdiǎnr — nearly; almost

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be scared, then the Mandarin for luckily.

You'll want to know: chàdiǎnr

chàdiǎnr — "nearly; almost".

> *wǒ chàdiǎnr chídào le* — I was nearly late.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chàdiǎnr is built from *chà* 'short of' and 点儿 'a little', inherited from Middle Chinese *tsrhae*, *temX* and *nye* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to choose' and 'to go wrong'; the falling tone of chà is not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: chàdiǎnr*
- *Say it: chàdiǎnr*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chàdiǎnr chídào le* — I was nearly late.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be scared, then the Mandarin for luckily, then say *chàdiǎnr* again

Before you move on

What does chàdiǎnr mean? ("Nearly; almost".) Say it once more.

Chapter 237

Plants

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about plants, peanuts, leaves, things sprouting and watermelons.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 237: I can talk about plants, peanuts, leaves, things sprouting and watermelons.*

237.1 zhíwù — plant

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for luckily, then the Mandarin for nearly.

You'll want to know: zhíwù

zhíwù — "plant".

> *wǒ xǐhuan zhíwù* — I love plants.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhíwù is built from *zhí* 'to plant' and *wù* 'thing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyik* and *mjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to plant' and 'to set up'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíwù*
- *Say it: zhíwù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan zhíwù* — I love plants.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for luckily, then the Mandarin for nearly, then say *zhíwù* again

Before you move on

What does zhíwù mean? ("Plant".) Say it once more.

237.2 花生 (huāshēng) — peanut

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for nearly, then the Mandarin for a plant.

You'll want to know: 花生

花生 — *huāshēng* — "peanut".

我现在不吃花生了 *wǒ xiànzài bù chī huāshēng le* — I don't eat peanuts any more.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

花生 (*huāshēng*) is built from 花 'flower' and 生 'to grow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwae* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); how the pair came to name the peanut is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: huāshēng*
- *Say it: huāshēng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiànzài bù chī huāshēng le* — I don't eat peanuts any more.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for nearly, then the Mandarin for a plant, then say *huāshēng* again

Before you move on

What does 花生 mean? ("Peanut".) Say it once more.

237.3 yèzi — leaf

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a plant, then the Mandarin for a peanut.

You'll want to know: yèzi

yèzi — "leaf".

zhèxiē yèzi hěn piàoliang — These leaves are lovely.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yèzi is built from *yè* 'leaf' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yep* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'branches and leaves'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yèzi*
- *Say it: yèzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhèxiē yèzi hěn piàoliang* — These leaves are lovely.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a plant, then the Mandarin for a peanut, then say *yèzi* again

Before you move on

What does yèzi mean? ("Leaf".) Say it once more.

237.4 fāyá — to sprout; to bud

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a peanut, then the Mandarin for a leaf.

You'll want to know: fāyá

fāyá — "to sprout; to bud".

chūntiān lái le xiǎo cǎo fāyá le — Spring is here, and the grass is coming up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāyá is built from *fā* 'to send out' and *yá* 'a shoot'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to rise' and 'to open out'; the dictionary glosses the second, *ngae* there, 'a sprout'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāyá*
- *Say it: fāyá*, once more
- *Say it: chūntiān lái le xiǎo cǎo fāyá le* — Spring is here, and the grass is coming up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a peanut, then the Mandarin for a leaf, then say *fāyá* again

Before you move on

What does fāyá mean? ("To sprout; to bud".) Say it once more.

237.5 xīguā — watermelon

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a leaf, then the Mandarin for to sprout.

You'll want to know: xīguā

xīguā — "watermelon".

xiàtiān wǒmen chángcháng chī xīguā — We eat a lot of watermelon in summer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīguā is built from 西 'west' and *guā* 'melon', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sej* and *kwae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a gourd and lists many kinds.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīguā*
- *Say it: xīguā*, once more
- *Say it: xiàtiān wǒmen chángcháng chī xīguā* — We eat a lot of watermelon in summer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a leaf, then the Mandarin for to sprout, then say *xīguā* again

Before you move on

What does xīguā mean? ("Watermelon".) Say it once more.

Chapter 238

Sea and Sky

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the sky, the moon, dark clouds, the open sea and a rainbow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 238: I can describe the sky, the moon, dark clouds, the open sea and a rainbow.*

238.1 tiānkōng — the sky

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sprout, then the Mandarin for a watermelon.

You'll want to know: tiānkōng

tiānkōng — "the sky".

> *jīntiān de tiānkōng hěn lán* — The sky is so blue today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiānkōng is built from 天 'heaven' and *kōng* 'empty', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *then* and *khuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'hollow'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānkōng*
- *Say it: tiānkōng*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de tiānkōng hěn lán* — The sky is so blue today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sprout, then the Mandarin for a watermelon, then say *tiānkōng* again

Before you move on

What does tiānkōng mean? ("The sky".) Say it once more.

238.2 yuèliang — the moon

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a watermelon, then the Mandarin for the sky.

You'll want to know: yuèliang

yuèliang — "the moon".

jīntiān wǎnshang yuèliang hěn dà — The moon is huge tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuèliang is built from 月 'moon' and *liang* 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwot* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'bright'; in the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuèliang*
- *Say it: yuèliang*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǎnshang yuèliang hěn dà* — The moon is huge tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a watermelon, then the Mandarin for the sky, then say *yuèliang* again

Before you move on

What does yuèliang mean? ("The moon".) Say it once more.

238.3 wūyún — dark clouds

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the sky, then the Mandarin for the moon.

You'll want to know: wūyún

wūyún — "dark clouds".

wūyún lái le yào xiàyǔ le — Dark clouds are coming in; it's about to rain.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wūyún is built from *wū* 'black as a crow' and 云 'cloud'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary explains the first, *'u* there, after an older book, as the crow that is all black.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: wūyún*
- *Say it: wūyún*, once more
- *Say it: wūyún lái le yào xiàyǔ le* — Dark clouds are coming in; it's about to rain.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the sky, then the Mandarin for the moon, then say *wūyún* again

Before you move on

What does wūyún mean? ("Dark clouds".) Say it once more.

238.4 dàhǎi — the open sea

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the moon, then the Mandarin for dark clouds.

You'll want to know: dàhǎi

dàhǎi — "the open sea".

wǒ hěn xǐhuan dàhǎi — I really love the sea.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàhǎi is built from 大 'big' and *hǎi* 'sea', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *xojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàhǎi*
- *Say it: dàhǎi*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ hěn xǐhuan dàhǎi* — I really love the sea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the moon, then the Mandarin for dark clouds, then say *dàhǎi* again

Before you move on

What does dàhǎi mean? ("The open sea".) Say it once more.

238.5 cǎihóng — rainbow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dark clouds, then the Mandarin for the open sea.

You'll want to know: cǎihóng

cǎihóng — "rainbow".

yǔ tíng le yǒu cǎihóng — The rain's stopped, and there's a rainbow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cǎihóng is built from *cǎi* 'colour' and *hóng* 'rainbow'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'brilliance'; the dictionary glosses the second, *huwng* there, with an old two-character word for the rainbow.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: cǎihóng*
- *Say it: cǎihóng*, once more
- *Say it: yǔ tíng le yǒu cǎihóng* — The rain's stopped, and there's a rainbow.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dark clouds, then the Mandarin for the open sea, then say *cǎihóng* again

Before you move on

What does cǎihóng mean? (“Rainbow”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 239

Healthy Habits

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about staying healthy, giving up smoking and drinking, breathing and having a check-up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 239: I can talk about staying healthy, giving up smoking and drinking, breathing and having a check-up.*

239.1 jiànkāng — healthy; health

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the open sea, then the Mandarin for a rainbow.

You'll want to know: jiànkāng

jiànkāng — "healthy; health".

> *tā měitiān pǎobù hěn jiànkāng* — He runs every day and he's very fit.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiànkāng is built from *jiàn* 'strong' and *kāng* 'at ease', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjonH* and *khang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'in harmony' and 'happy'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànkāng*
- *Say it: jiànkāng*, once more
- *Say it: tā měitiān pǎobù hěn jiànkāng* — He runs every day and he's very fit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the open sea, then the Mandarin for a rainbow, then say *jiànkāng* again

Before you move on

What does jiànkāng mean? ("Healthy; health".) Say it once more.

239.2 jièyān — to give up smoking

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a rainbow, then the Mandarin for healthy.

You'll want to know: jièyān

jièyān — "to give up smoking".

wèile shēntǐ wǒ bàba jièyān le — My dad gave up smoking for his health.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jièyān is built from *jiè* 'to guard against' and *yān* 'smoke'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *'en* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the breath of fire'; the dictionary glosses the first, *keajH* there, 'to be careful' and 'to warn'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jièyān*
- *Say it: jièyān*, once more
- *Say it: wèile shēntǐ wǒ bàba jièyān le* — My dad gave up smoking for his health.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a rainbow, then the Mandarin for healthy, then say *jièyān* again

Before you move on

What does jièyān mean? ("To give up smoking".) Say it once more.

239.3 hējiǔ — to drink alcohol

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for healthy, then the Mandarin for to give up smoking.

You'll want to know: hējiǔ

hējiǔ — "to drink alcohol".

tā bù xīyān yě bù hējiǔ — He doesn't smoke or drink.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hējiǔ is built from 喝 'to drink' and *jiǔ* 'alcohol', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xat* and *tsjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to shout', so how it came to mean drinking is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: hējiǔ*
- *Say it: hējiǔ*, once more
- *Say it: tā bù xīyān yě bù hējiǔ* — He doesn't smoke or drink.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for healthy, then the Mandarin for to give up smoking, then say *hējiǔ* again

Before you move on

What does hējiǔ mean? ("To drink alcohol".) Say it once more.

239.4 hūxī — to breathe

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give up smoking, then the Mandarin for to drink alcohol.

You'll want to know: hūxī

hūxī — "to breathe".

tā gǎnmào le bù néng yòng bízi hūxī — He's got a cold and can't breathe through his nose.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hūxī is built from *hū* 'to breathe out' and *xī* 'to breathe in', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xu* and *xip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to call' and, after an older book, 'the outward breath', and the second 'the inward breath'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: hūxī*
- *Say it: hūxī*, once more
- *Say it: tā gǎnmào le bù néng yòng bízi hūxī* — He's got a cold and can't breathe through his nose.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give up smoking, then the Mandarin for to drink alcohol, then say *hūxī* again

Before you move on

What does hūxī mean? ("To breathe".) Say it once more.

239.5 tǐjiǎn — medical check-up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to drink alcohol, then the Mandarin for to breathe.

You'll want to know: tǐjiǎn

tǐjiǎn — "medical check-up".

wǒ měi nián zuò yí cì tǐjiǎn — I have a check-up once a year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Tone: tǐ and jiǎn are both third tones, so the first rises and it sounds like tíjiǎn.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǐjiǎn is built from 体 'body' and *jiǎn* 'to check', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *kjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐjiǎn*
- *Say it: tǐjiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měi nián zuò yí cì tǐjiǎn* — I have a check-up once a year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to drink alcohol, then the Mandarin for to breathe, then say *tǐjiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does tǐjiǎn mean? ("Medical check-up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 240

Feeling Ill

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I'm ill and why: an infection, a swelling, being sick and an upset stomach.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 240: I can say I'm ill and why: an infection, a swelling, being sick and an upset stomach.*

240.1 生病 (shēngbìng) — to get sick; to fall ill

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to breathe, then the Mandarin for a medical check-up.

You'll want to know: 生病

生病 — *shēngbìng* — "to get sick; to fall ill".

> 我生病了头很疼不想吃东西 *wǒ shēngbìng le tóu hěn téng bù xiǎng chī dōngxi* — I'm ill: my head really hurts and I don't want to eat.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生病 (*shēngbìng*) is built from 生 'to grow' and 病 'illness', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *bjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'worry' and 'suffering' and explains it, after an older book, as an illness grown worse.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngbìng*
- *Say it: shēngbìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shēngbìng le tóu hěn téng bù xiǎng chī dōngxi* — I'm ill: my head really hurts and I don't want to eat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to breathe, then the Mandarin for a medical check-up, then say *shēngbìng* again

Before you move on

What does 生病 mean? ("To get sick; to fall ill".) Say it once more.

240.2 fāyán — to become inflamed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a medical check-up, then the Mandarin for to get sick.

You'll want to know: fāyán

fāyán — "to become inflamed".

wǒ de sǎngzi fāyán le — My throat is inflamed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāyán is built from *fā* 'to start' and *yán* 'flame', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *hjem* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'heat' and explains it, after an older book, as fire rising.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāyán*
- *Say it: fāyán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de sǎngzi fāyán le* — My throat is inflamed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a medical check-up, then the Mandarin for to get sick, then say *fāyán* again

Before you move on

What does fāyán mean? ("To become inflamed".) Say it once more.

240.3 zhǒng — swollen

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get sick, then the Mandarin for to become inflamed.

You'll want to know: zhǒng

zhǒng — "swollen".

tā de jiǎo zhǒng le — His foot has swollen up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǒng is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'an illness' and, after an older book, 'a boil'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǒng*
- *Say it: zhǒng*, once more

- *Say it: tā de jiǎo zhǒng le* — His foot has swollen up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get sick, then the Mandarin for to become inflamed, then say *zhǒng* again

Before you move on

What does zhǒng mean? ("Swollen".) Say it once more.

240.4 tù — to throw up; to vomit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to become inflamed, then the Mandarin for swollen.

You'll want to know: tù

tù — "to throw up; to vomit".

wǒ yùnchuán yǒudiǎnr xiǎng tù — I'm seasick and feel a bit like throwing up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tù is inherited from Middle Chinese *thuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to vomit'; the dictionary also lists the character with a rising tone for spitting out.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tù*
- *Say it: tù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yùnchuán yǒudiǎnr xiǎng tù* — I'm seasick and feel a bit like throwing up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to become inflamed, then the Mandarin for swollen, then say *tù* again

Before you move on

What does tù mean? ("To throw up; to vomit".) Say it once more.

240.5 lā dùzi — to have diarrhoea; to have an upset stomach

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for swollen, then the Mandarin for to throw up.

You'll want to know: lā dùzi

lā dùzi — "to have diarrhoea; to have an upset stomach".

tā zuótiān lā dùzi le — He had an upset stomach yesterday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lā dùzi is built from *lā* 'to pull' and *dùzi* 'belly', all three syllables inherited from Middle Chinese, *lop*, *duX* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to break'; how the phrase came to mean an upset stomach is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: lā dùzi*
- *Say it: lā dùzi*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuótiān lā dùzi le* — He had an upset stomach yesterday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for swollen, then the Mandarin for to throw up, then say *lā dùzi* again

Before you move on

What does lā dùzi mean? ("To have diarrhoea; to have an upset stomach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 241

In Hospital

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell how someone went into hospital, the ward, the operation, coming home and getting better.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 241: I can tell how someone went into hospital, the ward, the operation, coming home and getting better.*

241.1 zhùyuàn — to be in hospital

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to throw up, then the Mandarin for to have an upset stomach.

You'll want to know: zhùyuàn

zhùyuàn — "to be in hospital".

> *shàng ge yuè wǒ bàba zhùyuàn le* — Last month my dad went into hospital.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhùyuàn is built from *zhù* 'to stay' and *yuàn* 'a walled courtyard', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjuH* and *hjwenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stop' and the second 'a wall round a courtyard'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhùyuàn*
- *Say it: zhùyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: shàng ge yuè wǒ bàba zhùyuàn le* — Last month my dad went into hospital.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to throw up, then the Mandarin for to have an upset stomach, then say *zhùyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does zhùyuàn mean? ("To be in hospital".) Say it once more.

241.2 病房 (bìngfáng) — hospital ward

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have an upset stomach, then the Mandarin for to be in hospital.

You'll want to know: 病房

病房 — *bìngfáng* — "hospital ward".

医生现在在病房里 *yīshēng xiànzài zài bìngfáng lǐ* — The doctor's in the ward now.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

病房 (*bìngfáng*) is built from 病 'illness' and 房 'room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaengH* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a chamber'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìngfáng*
- *Say it: bìngfáng*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng xiànzài zài bìngfáng lǐ* — The doctor's in the ward now.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have an upset stomach, then the Mandarin for to be in hospital, then say *bìngfáng* again

Before you move on

What does 病房 mean? ("Hospital ward".) Say it once more.

241.3 shǒushù — surgical operation

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be in hospital, then the Mandarin for a hospital ward.

You'll want to know: shǒushù

shǒushù — "surgical operation".

tā zuòle yí cì shǒushù — He had an operation.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǒushù is built from 手 'hand' and *shù* 'skill', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *zywit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'skill'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒushù*
- *Say it: shǒushù*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuòle yí cì shǒushù* — He had an operation.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be in hospital, then the Mandarin for a hospital ward, then say *shǒushù* again

Before you move on

What does shǒushù mean? ("Surgical operation".) Say it once more.

241.4 chūyuàn — to leave hospital

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hospital ward, then the Mandarin for a surgical operation.

You'll want to know: chūyuàn

chūyuàn — "to leave hospital".

tā xià xīngqī kěyǐ chūyuàn — He can leave hospital next week.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūyuàn is built from 出 'to go out' and *yuàn* 'a walled courtyard', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *hjwenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūyuàn*
- *Say it: chūyuàn*, once more

- *Say it: tā xià xīngqī kěyǐ chūyuàn* — He can leave hospital next week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hospital ward, then the Mandarin for a surgical operation, then say *chūyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does chūyuàn mean? ("To leave hospital".) Say it once more.

241.5 huīfù — to recover; to get back to normal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a surgical operation, then the Mandarin for to leave hospital.

You'll want to know: huīfù

huīfù — "to recover; to get back to normal".

tā de shēntǐ huīfù de hěn kuài — He's recovering very quickly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huīfù is built from *huī* 'vast' and *fù* 'to return', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khwoj* and *bjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'great' and the second 'to return'. The h of huī is not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: huīfù*
- *Say it: huīfù*, once more
- *Say it: tā de shēntǐ huīfù de hěn kuài* — He's recovering very quickly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a surgical operation, then the Mandarin for to leave hospital, then say *huīfù* again

Before you move on

What does huīfù mean? ("To recover; to get back to normal".) Say it once more.

241.6 Looking back: from Something Odd to In Hospital

Say the Mandarin for to turn up and to find out.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to turn up, to find out, to be scared, luckily, nearly
- *Say it:* a plant, a peanut, a leaf, to sprout, a watermelon
- *Say it:* the sky, the moon, dark clouds, the open sea, a rainbow
- *Say it:* healthy, to give up smoking, to drink alcohol, to breathe, a medical check-up
- *Say it:* to get sick, to become inflamed, swollen, to throw up, to have an upset stomach
- *Say it:* to be in hospital, a hospital ward, a surgical operation, to leave hospital, to recover
- *Read it:* 现 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To turn up? (出现, *chūxiàn.*) To find out? (*fāxiàn.*) To be scared? (*hàipà.*) Luckily? (*xìnghǎo.*) Nearly? (*chàdiǎnr.*) A plant? (*zhíwù.*) A peanut? (花生, *huāshēng.*) A leaf? (*yèzi.*) To sprout? (*fāyá.*) A watermelon? (*xīguā.*) The sky? (*tiānkōng.*) The moon? (*yuèliang.*) Dark clouds? (*wūyún.*) The open sea? (*dàhǎi.*) A rainbow? (*cǎihóng.*) Healthy? (*jiànkāng.*) To give up smoking? (*jièyān.*) To drink alcohol? (*hējiǔ.*) To breathe? (*hūxī.*) A medical check-up? (*tǐjiǎn.*) To get sick? (生病, *shēngbìng.*) To become inflamed? (*fāyán.*) Swollen? (*zhǒng.*) To throw up? (*tù.*) To have an upset stomach? (*lā dùzi.*) To be in hospital? (*zhùyuàn.*) A hospital ward?

(**病房**, *bìngfáng.*) A surgical operation? (*shǒushù.*) To leave hospital? (*chūyuàn.*) To recover? (*huīfù.*)

Chapter 242

Farm Animals and Bugs

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a pig, a goat, a snake, insects and mosquitoes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 242: I can name a pig, a goat, a snake, insects and mosquitoes.*

242.1 zhū — pig

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leave hospital, then the Mandarin for to recover.

You'll want to know: zhū

zhū — "pig".

> *tā jiā yǒu sān zhī zhū* — His family keeps three pigs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhū is inherited from Middle Chinese *trjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it, after an older dictionary, as the young of the pig.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhū*
- *Say it: zhū*, once more
- *Say it: tā jiā yǒu sān zhī zhū* — His family keeps three pigs.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leave hospital, then the Mandarin for to recover, then say *zhū* again

Before you move on

What does zhū mean? ("Pig".) Say it once more.

242.2 shānyáng — goat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to recover, then the Mandarin for a pig.

You'll want to know: shānyáng

shānyáng — "goat".

zhè zhī shānyáng hěn xǐhuan chī cǎo — This goat loves eating grass.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shānyáng is built from 山 'hill' and *yáng* 'sheep'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *srean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second, *yang* there, with the pair 'oxen and sheep'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shānyáng*
- *Say it: shānyáng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè zhī shānyáng hěn xǐhuan chī cǎo* — This goat loves eating grass.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to recover, then the Mandarin for a pig, then say *shānyáng* again

Before you move on

What does shānyáng mean? ("Goat".) Say it once more.

242.3 shé — snake

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pig, then the Mandarin for a goat.

You'll want to know: shé

shé — "snake".

wǒ hěn pà shé — I'm terrified of snakes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shé is inherited from Middle Chinese *zyae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a venomous creature'.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shé*
- *Say it: shé*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ hěn pà shé* — I'm terrified of snakes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pig, then the Mandarin for a goat, then say *shé* again

Before you move on

What does shé mean? ("Snake".) Say it once more.

242.4 chóngzi — insect; bug

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a goat, then the Mandarin for a snake.

You'll want to know: chóngzi

chóngzi — "insect; bug".

wǒ nǚ'ér bú pà chóngzi — My daughter isn't afraid of bugs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chóngzi is built from *chóng* 'insect' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjuwng* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says, after an older dictionary, that creatures with feet are called by the first.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chóngzi*
- *Say it: chóngzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nǚ'ér bú pà chóngzi* — My daughter isn't afraid of bugs.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a goat, then the Mandarin for a snake, then say *chóngzi* again

Before you move on

What does chóngzi mean? ("Insect; bug".) Say it once more.

242.5 wénzi — mosquito

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a snake, then the Mandarin for a bug.

You'll want to know: wénzi

wénzi — "mosquito".

xiàtiān zhèr yǒu wénzi — There are mosquitoes here in summer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wénzi is built from *wén* 'mosquito' and the noun ending 子. The noun ending is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the first, *mjun* there, beside another form of the character.

What you've built

One more word for everyday things.

Your turn

- *Say it: wénzi*
- *Say it: wénzi*, once more
- *Say it: xiàtiān zhèr yǒu wénzi* — There are mosquitoes here in summer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a snake, then the Mandarin for a bug, then say *wénzi* again

Before you move on

What does wénzi mean? (“Mosquito”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 243

Changing Seasons

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the climate, snowflakes, the weather changing, ice on the lake and the temperature.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 243: I can describe the climate, snowflakes, the weather changing, ice on the lake and the temperature.*

243.1 气候 (qìhòu) — climate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bug, then the Mandarin for a mosquito.

You'll want to know: 气候

气候 — *qìhòu* — "climate".

> 西边的气候不好风很大 *xībiān de qìhòu bù hǎo fēng hěn dà* — The climate in the west isn't good: it's very windy.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

气候 (*qìhòu*) is built from 气 'air' and 候 'a season', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khj+jH* and *huwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to wait on'; the sense of a season is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: qìhòu*
- *Say it: qìhòu*, once more
- *Say it: xībiān de qìhòu bù hǎo fēng hěn dà* — The climate in the west isn't good: it's very windy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bug, then the Mandarin for a mosquito, then say *qìhòu* again

Before you move on

What does 气候 mean? ("Climate".) Say it once more.

243.2 雪花 (xuěhuā) — snowflake

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a mosquito, then the Mandarin for climate.

You'll want to know: 雪花

雪花 — *xuěhuā* — "snowflake".

今天多云外边有雪花 *jīntiān duōyún wàibian yǒu xuěhuā* — It's cloudy today, and there are snowflakes outside.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

雪花 (*xuěhuā*) is built from 雪 'snow' and 花 'flower', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjwet* and *xwae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuěhuā*
- *Say it: xuěhuā*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān duōyún wàibian yǒu xuěhuā* — It's cloudy today, and there are snowflakes outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a mosquito, then the Mandarin for climate, then say *xuěhuā* again

Before you move on

What does 雪花 mean? ("Snowflake".) Say it once more.

243.3 biànhuà — to change over time; a change

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for climate, then the Mandarin for a snowflake.

You'll want to know: biànhuà

biànhuà — "to change over time; a change".

zhèr de tiānqì biànhuà hěn dà — The weather here changes a lot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biànhuà is built from *biàn* 'to alter' and *huà* 'to transform', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjenH* and *xwaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each with the other.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: biànhuà*
- *Say it: biànhuà*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de tiānqì biànhuà hěn dà* — The weather here changes a lot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for climate, then the Mandarin for a snowflake, then say *biànhuà* again

Before you move on

What does biànhuà mean? ("To change over time; a change".) Say it once more.

243.4 jiébīng — to freeze over

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a snowflake, then the Mandarin for to change over time.

You'll want to know: jiébīng

jiébīng — "to freeze over".

dōngtiān hú lǐ de shuǐ jiébīng le — In winter the water in the lake freezes over.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiébīng is built from *jié* 'to knot' and *bīng* 'ice', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ket* and *ping* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tie' and the second 'water frozen'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiébīng*
- *Say it: jiébīng*, once more
- *Say it: dōngtiān hú lǐ de shuǐ jiébīng le* — In winter the water in the lake freezes over.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a snowflake, then the Mandarin for to change over time, then say *jiébīng* again

Before you move on

What does jiébīng mean? ("To freeze over".) Say it once more.

243.5 wēndù — temperature

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change over time, then the Mandarin for to freeze over.

You'll want to know: wēndù

wēndù — "temperature".

jīntiān wēndù bù gāo — It's not very warm today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wēndù is built from *wēn* 'warm' and *dù* 'a measure', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'won* and *duH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a rule'; the sense of a degree on a scale is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: wēndù*
- *Say it: wēndù*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wēndù bù gāo* — It's not very warm today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change over time, then the Mandarin for to freeze over, then say *wēndù* again

Before you move on

What does wēndù mean? ("Temperature".) Say it once more.

Chapter 244

A Storm Coming

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about plans when a typhoon or showers may come: who knows, in case, and carrying on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 244: I can talk about plans when a typhoon or showers may come: who knows, in case, and carrying on.*

244.1 táifēng — typhoon

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to freeze over, then the Mandarin for temperature.

You'll want to know: táifēng

táifēng — "typhoon".

> *hòutiān huì yǒu táifēng* — There'll be a typhoon the day after tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

táifēng is built from *tái* and 风 'wind'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first in this sense, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: táifēng*
- *Say it: táifēng*, once more
- *Say it: hòutiān huì yǒu táifēng* — There'll be a typhoon the day after tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to freeze over, then the Mandarin for temperature, then say *táifēng* again

Before you move on

What does táifēng mean? ("Typhoon".) Say it once more.

244.2 zhènyǔ — a rain shower

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for temperature, then the Mandarin for a typhoon.

You'll want to know: zhènyǔ

zhènyǔ — "a rain shower".

míngtiān xiàwǔ yǒu zhènyǔ — There'll be showers tomorrow afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhènyǔ is built from *zhèn* 'a spell' and 雨 'rain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drinH* and *hjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the first only as the everyday form of another character, and the sense 'a spell' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhènyǔ*
- *Say it: zhènyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān xiàwǔ yǒu zhènyǔ* — There'll be showers tomorrow afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for temperature, then the Mandarin for a typhoon, then say *zhènyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does zhènyǔ mean? ("A rain shower".) Say it once more.

244.3 shuōbudìng — perhaps; who knows

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a typhoon, then the Mandarin for a rain shower.

You'll want to know: shuōbudìng

shuōbudìng — "perhaps; who knows".

shuōbudìng míngtiān huì xiàyǔ — Who knows, it might rain tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Tone: 不 is light here, bu, with no tone of its own.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuōbudìng is built from 说 'to say', 不 'not' and *dìng* 'fixed', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sywet*, *pjut* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'settled'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuōbudìng*
- *Say it: shuōbudìng*, once more
- *Say it: shuōbudìng míngtiān huì xiàyǔ* — Who knows, it might rain tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a typhoon, then the Mandarin for a rain shower, then say *shuōbudìng* again

Before you move on

What does shuōbudìng mean? ("Perhaps; who knows".) Say it once more.

244.4 wànyī — in case; if by any chance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a rain shower, then the Mandarin for who knows.

You'll want to know: wànyī

wànyī — "in case; if by any chance".

wànyī xiàyǔ zěnme bàn — What if it rains?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Tone: — keeps its first tone here, yī, because it ends the word.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wànyī is built from *wàn* 'ten thousand' and — 'one', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonH* and *'jit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); it is usually explained as one chance in ten thousand.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: wànyī*
- *Say it: wànyī*, once more
- *Say it: wànyī xiàyǔ zěnme bàn* — What if it rains?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a rain shower, then the Mandarin for who knows, then say *wànyī* again

Before you move on

What does wànyī mean? ("In case; if by any chance".) Say it once more.

244.5 jìxù — to carry on; to continue

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for who knows, then the Mandarin for in case.

You'll want to know: jìxù

jìxù — "to carry on; to continue".

yǔ tíng le wǒmen jìxù zǒu — The rain's stopped; let's carry on.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìxù is built from *jì* 'to continue' and *xù* 'to join on'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *zjowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to continue' and 'to join'; the dictionary glosses the first, *kejH* there, 'to carry on'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about plans.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìxù*
- *Say it: jìxù*, once more
- *Say it: yǔ tíng le wǒmen jìxù zǒu* — The rain's stopped; let's carry on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for who knows, then the Mandarin for in case, then say *jìxù* again

Before you move on

What does jìxù mean? ("To carry on; to continue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 245

Take Care

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can explain why I take my temperature, keep a mask and stay home, and tell someone to look after themselves.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 245: I can explain why I take my temperature, keep a mask and stay home, and tell someone to look after themselves.*

245.1 tǐwēn — body temperature

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in case, then the Mandarin for to carry on.

You'll want to know: tǐwēn

tǐwēn — "body temperature".

> *nǐ de tǐwēn yǒudiǎnr gāo* — Your temperature's a bit high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǐwēn is built from 体 'body' and *wēn* 'warm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *'won* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐwēn*
- *Say it: tǐwēn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de tǐwēn yǒudiǎnr gāo* — Your temperature's a bit high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in case, then the Mandarin for to carry on, then say *tǐwēn* again

Before you move on

What does tǐwēn mean? ("Body temperature".) Say it once more.

245.2 chuánrǎn — to pass on (an illness); to be catching

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to carry on, then the Mandarin for body temperature.

You'll want to know: chuánrǎn

chuánrǎn — "to pass on (an illness); to be catching".

yīnwèi gǎnmào huì chuánrǎn suǒyǐ wǒ bú qù shàngbān — Colds are catching, so I'm not going in to work.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuánrǎn is built from *chuán* 'to pass on' and *rǎn* 'to dye', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjwen* and *nyemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn' and the second 'to dye'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuánrǎn*
- *Say it: chuánrǎn*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi gǎnmào huì chuánrǎn suǒyǐ wǒ bú qù shàngbān* — Colds are catching, so I'm not going in to work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to carry on, then the Mandarin for body temperature, then say *chuánrǎn* again

Before you move on

What does chuánrǎn mean? ("To pass on (an illness); to be catching".) Say it once more.

245.3 kǒuzhào — face mask

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for body temperature, then the Mandarin for to be catching.

You'll want to know: kǒuzhào

kǒuzhào — "face mask".

nǐ yǒu kǒuzhào ma — Have you got a face mask?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kǒuzhào is built from 口 'mouth' and *zhào* 'a cover', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuwX* and *traewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a bamboo basket for catching fish, so how it came to mean a cover is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǒuzhào*
- *Say it: kǒuzhào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu kǒuzhào ma* — Have you got a face mask?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for body temperature, then the Mandarin for to be catching, then say *kǒuzhào* again

Before you move on

What does kǒuzhào mean? ("Face mask".) Say it once more.

245.4 xīnqíng — mood; frame of mind

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be catching, then the Mandarin for a face mask.

You'll want to know: xīnqíng

xīnqíng — "mood; frame of mind".

shēngbìng le xīnqíng bù hǎo — Being ill puts me in a bad mood.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnqíng is built from 忄 'heart' and *qíng* 'feeling', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the second, after an older book, as what a person desires.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnqíng*
- *Say it: xīnqíng*, once more
- *Say it: shēngbìng le xīnqíng bù hǎo* — Being ill puts me in a bad mood.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be catching, then the Mandarin for a face mask, then say *xīnqíng* again

Before you move on

What does xīnqíng mean? ("Mood; frame of mind".) Say it once more.

245.5 bǎozhòng — to look after yourself; to take care of oneself

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a face mask, then the Mandarin for mood.

You'll want to know: bǎozhòng

bǎozhòng — "to look after yourself; to take care of oneself".

nǐ shēngbìng le yào bǎozhòng — You're ill, so look after yourself.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎozhòng is built from *bǎo* 'to keep' and 重 'heavy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *drjowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be responsible for' and 'to keep safe'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎozhòng*
- *Say it: bǎozhòng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shēngbìng le yào bǎozhòng* — You're ill, so look after yourself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a face mask, then the Mandarin for mood, then say *bǎozhòng* again

Before you move on

What does bǎozhòng mean? ("To look after yourself; to take care of oneself".) Say it once more.

Chapter 246

Out in the Hills

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a village, a bridge, stones, a pond and rowing a boat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 246: I can talk about a village, a bridge, stones, a pond and rowing a boat.*

246.1 cūnzi — village

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for mood, then the Mandarin for to look after yourself.

You'll want to know: cūnzi

cūnzi — "village".

> *zhège cūnzi hěn xiǎo* — This village is tiny.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cūnzi is built from *cūn* 'village' and the noun ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshwon* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūnzi*
- *Say it: cūnzi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège cūnzi hěn xiǎo* — This village is tiny.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for mood, then the Mandarin for to look after yourself, then say *cūnzi* again

Before you move on

What does cūnzi mean? ("Village".) Say it once more.

246.2 qiáo — bridge

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look after yourself, then the Mandarin for a village.

You'll want to know: qiáo

qiáo — "bridge".

cūnzi lǐ de qiáo hěn lǎo — The bridge in the village is very old.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiáo is inherited from Middle Chinese *gjew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a beam over water'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiáo*
- *Say it: qiáo*, once more
- *Say it: cūnzi lǐ de qiáo hěn lǎo* — The bridge in the village is very old.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look after yourself, then the Mandarin for a village, then say *qiáo* again

Before you move on

What does qiáo mean? ("Bridge".) Say it once more.

246.3 shítou — stone; rock

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a village, then the Mandarin for a bridge.

You'll want to know: shítou

shítou — "stone; rock".

nà kuài shítou hěn dà — That rock is huge.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shítou is built from *shí* 'stone' and 头, here a light noun ending, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyek* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as the body of a mountain.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: shítou*
- *Say it: shítou*, once more
- *Say it: nà kuài shítou hěn dà* — That rock is huge.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a village, then the Mandarin for a bridge, then say *shítou* again

Before you move on

What does shítou mean? ("Stone; rock".) Say it once more.

246.4 chítáng — pond

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bridge, then the Mandarin for a stone.

You'll want to know: chítáng

chítáng — "pond".

cūnzi lǐ yǒu yí ge chítáng — There's a pond in the village.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chítáng is built from *chí* 'a pool' and *táng* 'a bank'. The dictionary (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription) explains the first, *drje* there, as standing water, and glosses the second, *dang* there, with a word for a dyked pond.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: chítáng*
- *Say it: chítáng*, once more
- *Say it: cūnzi lǐ yǒu yí ge chítáng* — There's a pond in the village.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bridge, then the Mandarin for a stone, then say *chítáng* again

Before you move on

What does chítáng mean? ("Pond".) Say it once more.

246.5 huáchuán — to row a boat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a stone, then the Mandarin for a pond.

You'll want to know: huáchuán

huáchuán — "to row a boat".

zhōumò wǒmen qù gōngyuán huáchuán — At weekends we go rowing in the park.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huáchuán is built from *huá* 'to pole along' and *chuán* 'boat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwae* and *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to push a boat forward'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: huáchuán*
- *Say it: huáchuán*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen qù gōngyuán huáchuán* — At weekends we go rowing in the park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a stone, then the Mandarin for a pond, then say *huáchuán* again

Before you move on

What does huáchuán mean? ("To row a boat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 247

Back From a Trip

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a trip: what I went through, how pleasant it was, local specialities, souvenirs and memories.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 247: I can talk about a trip: what I went through, how pleasant it was, local specialities, souvenirs and memories.*

247.1 jīnglì — an experience (something lived through)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pond, then the Mandarin for to row a boat.

You'll want to know: jīnglì

jīnglì — "an experience (something lived through)".

> *zhè cì lǚyóu shì yí cì hěn hǎo de jīnglì* — This trip was a great experience.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīnglì is built from *jīng* 'to pass through' and *lì* 'to go through', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keng* and *lek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to pass' and 'to go'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīnglì*
- *Say it: jīnglì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè cì lǚyóu shì yí cì hěn hǎo de jīnglì* — This trip was a great experience.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pond, then the Mandarin for to row a boat, then say *jīnglì* again

Before you move on

What does jīnglì mean? ("An experience (something lived through)".) Say it once more.

247.2 yúkuài — pleasant; cheerful

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to row a boat, then the Mandarin for something lived through.

You'll want to know: yúkuài

yúkuài — "pleasant; cheerful".

zhōumò wǒmen wán de hěn yúkuài — We had a lovely time at the weekend.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yúkuài is built from *yú* 'glad' and 快 'pleased', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yu* and *khwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'pleased' and 'happy' and the second 'to one's liking' and 'glad'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: yúkuài*
- *Say it: yúkuài*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen wán de hěn yúkuài* — We had a lovely time at the weekend.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to row a boat, then the Mandarin for something lived through, then say *yúkuài* again

Before you move on

What does yúkuài mean? ("Pleasant; cheerful".) Say it once more.

247.3 tèchǎn — a local speciality; a regional product

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for something lived through, then the Mandarin for pleasant and cheerful.

You'll want to know: tèchǎn

tèchǎn — "a local speciality; a regional product".

zhèr de tèchǎn hěn hǎochī — The local specialities here are delicious.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tèchǎn is built from *tè* 'special' and *chǎn* 'to produce', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dok* and *sreanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a bull' and 'alone' and the second 'to give birth'; the ch of chǎn is not the regular outcome of that form.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: tèchǎn*
- *Say it: tèchǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de tèchǎn hěn hǎochī* — The local specialities here are delicious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for something lived through, then the Mandarin for pleasant and cheerful, then say *tèchǎn* again

Before you move on

What does tèchǎn mean? ("A local speciality; a regional product".) Say it once more.

247.4 jìniànpǐn — souvenir

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pleasant and cheerful, then the Mandarin for a local speciality.

You'll want to know: jìniànpǐn

jìniànpǐn — "souvenir".

wǒ mǎile liǎng ge jìniànpǐn — I bought two souvenirs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìniànpǐn is built from *jì* 'to record', *niàn* 'to think of' and *pǐn* 'an article', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *kiX*, *nemH* and *phimX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to think' and the third 'a kind' and 'a rank'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìniànpǐn*
- *Say it: jìniànpǐn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎile liǎng ge jìniànpǐn* — I bought two souvenirs.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pleasant and cheerful, then the Mandarin for a local speciality, then say *jìniànpǐn* again

Before you move on

What does jìniànpǐn mean? ("Souvenir".) Say it once more.

247.5 huíyì — to recall; to think back on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a local speciality, then the Mandarin for a souvenir.

You'll want to know: huíyì

huíyì — "to recall; to think back on".

wǒ chángcháng huíyì nà cì lǚyóu — I often think back to that trip.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huíyì is built from 回 'to return' and *yì* 'to remember'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second, *'ik* there, 'to think of'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: huíyì*
- *Say it: huíyì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chángcháng huíyì nà cì lǚyóu* — I often think back to that trip.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a local speciality, then the Mandarin for a souvenir, then say *huíyì* again

Before you move on

What does huíyì mean? ("To recall; to think back on".) Say it once more.

247.6 Looking back: from Farm Animals and Bugs to Back From a Trip

Say the Mandarin for a pig and a goat.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a pig, a goat, a snake, a bug, a mosquito
- climate, a snowflake, to change over time, to freeze over, temperature
- a typhoon, a rain shower, who knows, in case, to carry on

- body temperature, to be catching, a face mask, mood, to look after yourself
- a village, a bridge, a stone, a pond, to row a boat
- something lived through, pleasant and cheerful, a local speciality, a souvenir, to think back on

Before you move on

A pig? (*zhū.*) A goat? (*shānyáng.*) A snake? (*shé.*) A bug? (*chóngzi.*) A mosquito? (*wénzi.*) Climate? (气候, *qìhòu.*) A snowflake? (雪花, *xuěhuā.*) To change over time? (*biànhuà.*) To freeze over? (*jiébīng.*) Temperature? (*wēndù.*) A typhoon? (*táifēng.*) A rain shower? (*zhènyǔ.*) Who knows? (*shuōbudìng.*) In case? (*wànyī.*) To carry on? (*jìxù.*) Body temperature? (*tǐwēn.*) To be catching? (*chuánrǎn.*) A face mask? (*kǒuzhào.*) Mood? (*xīnqíng.*) To look after yourself? (*bǎozhòng.*) A village? (*cūnzi.*) A bridge? (*qiáo.*) A stone? (*shítou.*) A pond? (*chítáng.*) To row a boat? (*huáchuán.*) Something lived through? (*jīnglì.*) Pleasant and cheerful? (*yúkuài.*) A local speciality? (*tèchǎn.*) A souvenir? (*jìniànpǐn.*) To think back on? (*huíyì.*)

247.7 Back From a Trip — once more

Say the Mandarin for something lived through and pleasant and cheerful.

Your turn

- *Say it:* something lived through, pleasant and cheerful, a local speciality, a souvenir, to think back on

Before you move on

Something lived through? (*jīnglì.*) Pleasant and cheerful? (*yúkuài.*) A local speciality? (*tèchǎn.*) A souvenir? (*jìniànpǐn.*) To think back on? (*huíyì.*)

Chapter 248

A New Term

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the school term, my year group, the head teacher, senior high school and parents.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 248: I can talk about the school term, my year group, the head teacher, senior high school and parents.*

248.1 学期 (xuéqī) — school term; semester

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for souvenir, then the Mandarin for to recall.

You'll want to know: 学期

学期 — *xuéqī* — "school term; semester".

这个学期很长 *zhège xuéqī hěn cháng* — This term is a long one.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

学期 (*xuéqī*) is built from 学 'to study' and 期 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haewk* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to meet' and 'a limit'. Middle Chinese *gi* would regularly give a rising tone, qí; the level tone of qī is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuéqī*
- *Say it: xuéqī*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xuéqī hěn cháng* — This term is a long one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for souvenir, then the Mandarin for to recall, then say *xuéqī* again

Before you move on

What does 学期 mean? ("School term; semester".) Say it once more.

248.2 niánjí — year; grade (at school)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to recall, then the Mandarin for a school term.

You'll want to know: niánjí

niánjí — "year; grade (at school)".

wǒmen niánjí yǒu yìbǎi ge xuésheng — There are a hundred students in our year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niánjí is built from 年 'a year' and *jí* 'a rank', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nen* and *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'rank' and quotes an older dictionary for it, 'the order of silk threads'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: niánjí*
- *Say it: niánjí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen niánjí yǒu yìbǎi ge xuésheng* — There are a hundred students in our year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to recall, then the Mandarin for a school term, then say *niánjí* again

Before you move on

What does niánjí mean? ("Year; grade (at school)".) Say it once more.

248.3 校长 (xiàozhǎng) — head teacher; principal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a school term, then the Mandarin for a year group at school.

You'll want to know: 校长

校长 — *xiàozhǎng* — "head teacher; principal".

他是我们学校的校长 *tā shì wǒmen xuéxiào de xiàozhǎng* — He's the head of our school.

The new character, in pieces: 校 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left the tree piece, four strokes, as on the left of 机; on the right a dot and a bar, two short strokes under them, then a long stroke falling to the left crossed by a long stroke falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

校长 (*xiàozhǎng*) is built from 校 'a school' and 长 'the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haewH* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'big'; it lists the first in the title of an army officer, and the sense 'school' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàozhǎng*
- *Say it: xiàozhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒmen xuéxiào de xiàozhǎng* — He's the head of our school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a school term, then the Mandarin for a year group at school, then say *xiàozhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 校长 mean? ("Head teacher; principal".) Say it once more.

248.4 校 — the tree piece, then a lid and a cross

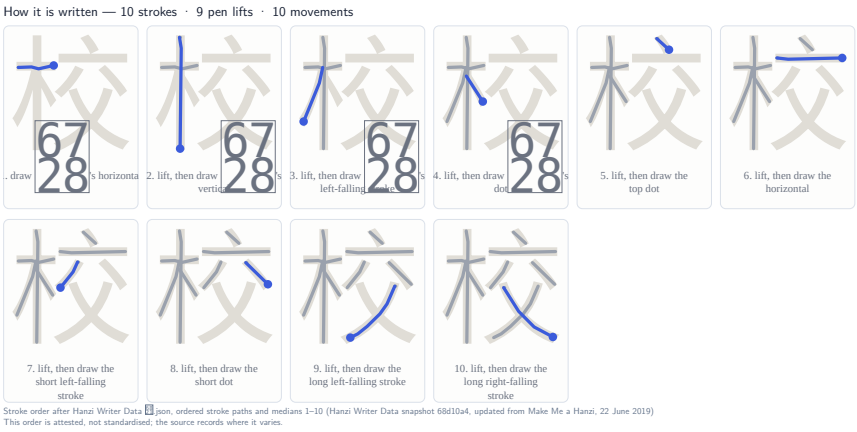
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiàozhǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  机 学

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jī*, *xué*

Script — the tree piece, then a lid and a cross



How 校 *is written, stroke by stroke*

校

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the tree piece, four strokes. A short bar. A vertical down through it. A stroke falling to the left from the crossing. Then a short dot to the right: on the left of a character the last stroke is a dot, not a long sweep.

The right piece, six strokes. A dot on top and a bar under it. Two short strokes under the bar, the left one falling to the left, the right one a dot. Then a long stroke falling to the left and, across it, a long stroke falling to the right to the foot.

4 + 6 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 校, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 校? (**Ten.**) What is the left piece? (**The tree piece, four strokes, as in 机.**) What are the last two strokes? (**A long fall to the left, crossed by a long fall to the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 校, pinned stroke paths and medians.

248.5 高中 (gāozhōng) — senior high school

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a year group at school, then the Mandarin for a head teacher.

You'll want to know: 高中

高中 — *gāozhōng* — "senior high school".

我们学校有高中 *wǒmen xuéxiào yǒu gāozhōng* — Our school has a senior high section.

The new character, in pieces: 高 — ten strokes: a dot and a long bar, then 口; under them a frame open at the foot, with a small 口 inside it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

高中 (*gāozhōng*) is built from 高 'high' and 中 'middle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *trjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'up' and 'lofty': the higher middle school, a short form of a longer name.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāozhōng*
- *Say it: gāozhōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xuéxiào yǒu gāozhōng* — Our school has a senior high section.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a year group at school, then the Mandarin for a head teacher, then say *gāozhōng* again

Before you move on

What does 高中 mean? ("Senior high school".) Say it once more.

248.6 高 — a lid, 口, then a frame around a small 口

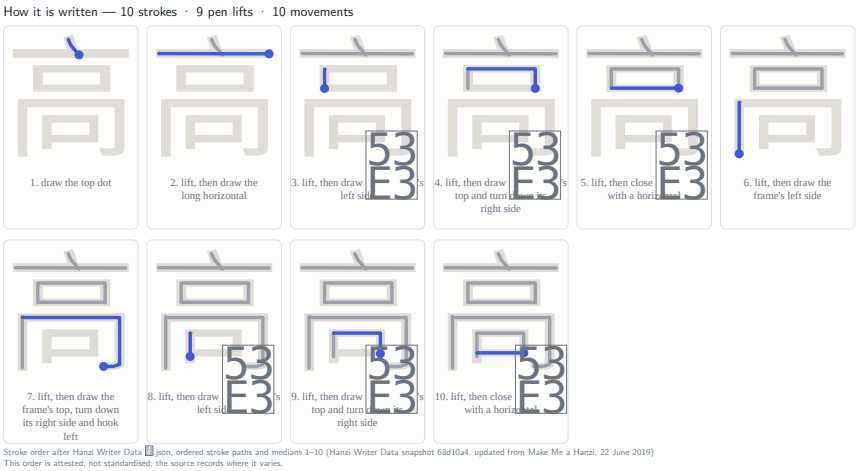
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gāozhōng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

口 中

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *zhōng*

Script — a lid, 口, then a frame around a small 口



How 高 is written, stroke by stroke

高

Three pieces, top to bottom.

The lid, two strokes. A dot, then a long bar across.

The middle piece, 口, three strokes. A short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, then the bar that closes the foot.

The bottom piece, five strokes. A vertical down the left. A bar across the top that turns down the right side and hooks to the left at the foot. Then a small 口 inside the frame, three strokes as before.

2 + 3 + 5 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 高, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 高? (**Ten**.) How many 口 does it hold? (**Two: one in the middle, a small one inside the frame**.) Is the frame closed at the foot? (**No, it is open**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 高, pinned stroke paths and medians.

248.7 家长 (jiāzhǎng) — pupil's parent; parent of a schoolchild

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a head teacher, then the Mandarin for senior high school.

You'll want to know: 家长

家长 — *jiāzhǎng* — "pupil's parent; parent of a schoolchild".

今天家长来学校 *jīntiān jiāzhǎng lái xuéxiào* — The parents are coming to school today.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

家长 (*jiāzhǎng*) is built from 家 'a home' and 长 'the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the head of a household, and at school a

pupil's parent.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāzhǎng*
- *Say it: jiāzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān jiāzhǎng lái xuéxiào* — The parents are coming to school today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a head teacher, then the Mandarin for senior high school, then say *jiāzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 家长 mean? ("Pupil's parent; parent of a schoolchild".) Say it once more.

Chapter 249

Hitting the Books

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about preparing a lesson, when school finishes, how a character is said, marks and working hard.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 249: I can talk about preparing a lesson, when school finishes, how a character is said, marks and working hard.*

249.1 yùxí — to prepare a lesson (before class)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for senior high school, then the Mandarin for a pupil's parent.

You'll want to know: yùxí

yùxí — "to prepare a lesson (before class)".

> *míngtiān de kè nǐ yùxí le ma* — Have you prepared tomorrow's lesson?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùxí is built from *yù* 'beforehand' and *xí* 'to practise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yoH* and *zip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, among other senses, 'before', and

the second 'to learn'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùxí*
- *Say it: yùxí*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān de kè nǐ yùxí le ma* — Have you prepared tomorrow's lesson?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for senior high school, then the Mandarin for a pupil's parent, then say *yùxí* again

Before you move on

What does yùxí mean? ("To prepare a lesson (before class)".) Say it once more.

249.2 fàngxué — to finish school for the day; (of a school) to let out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pupil's parent, then the Mandarin for to prepare a lesson.

You'll want to know: fàngxué

fàngxué — "to finish school for the day; (of a school) to let out".

wǒmen xiàwǔ sì diǎn fàngxué — We finish school at four in the afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàngxué is built from *fàng* 'to let go' and 学 'to study', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjangH* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'to drive out' and 'to send away'. Letting pupils go home from school is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàngxué*
- *Say it: fàngxué*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiàwǔ sì diǎn fàngxué* — We finish school at four in the afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pupil's parent, then the Mandarin for to prepare a lesson, then say *fàngxué* again

Before you move on

What does fàngxué mean? ("To finish school for the day; (of a school) to let out".) Say it once more.

249.3 读音 (dúyīn) — pronunciation; how a character is read

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to prepare a lesson, then the Mandarin for to finish school for the day.

You'll want to know: 读音

读音 — *dúyīn* — "pronunciation; how a character is read".

这个字的读音是什么 *zhège zì de dúyīn shì shénme* — How do you say this character?

The new character, in pieces: 读 — ten strokes: the speech piece 讠 on the left; on the right a short 十 over 买. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

读音 (*dúyīn*) is built from 读 'to read aloud' and 音 'a sound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwk* and *'im* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to recite' and quotes an older dictionary for the second: 'sound'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dúyīn*
- *Say it: dúyīn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège zì de dúyīn shì shénme* — How do you say this character?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to prepare a lesson, then the Mandarin for to finish school for the day, then say *dúyīn* again

Before you move on

What does 读音 mean? ("Pronunciation; how a character is read".) Say it once more.

249.4 读 — the speech piece, then 十 over 买

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dúyīn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  说 音

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shuō*, *yīn*

Script — the speech piece, then 十 over 买

How 读 *is written, stroke by stroke*

读

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, 讠, two strokes, as in 说 and 请: a dot, then a short bar to the right that turns down and flicks up to the right, all one stroke.

The right piece, eight strokes, top to bottom. First a short 十: a bar and a vertical through it. Then 买, six strokes, as you wrote it: a bar that turns down at its right end and hooks, two short dots, then a long bar, a stroke falling to the left, and a short dot at the foot.

2 + 8 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 读, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 读? (**Ten.**) Which piece is on the left? (**讠, the speech piece.**) What sits under 十? (买.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 读, pinned stroke paths and medians.

249.5 chéngjì — results; marks

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to finish school for the day, then the Mandarin for how a character is read.

You'll want to know: chéngjì

chéngjì — "results; marks".

tā de chéngjì hěn hǎo — His marks are very good.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngjì is built from *chéng* 'to complete' and *jì* 'a deed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *tsek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to finish' and the second 'merit' and 'a deed'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngjì*
- *Say it: chéngjì*, once more
- *Say it: tā de chéngjì hěn hǎo* — His marks are very good.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to finish school for the day, then the Mandarin for how a character is read, then say *chéngjì* again

Before you move on

What does chéngjì mean? ("Results; marks".) Say it once more.

249.6 nǔlì — hard-working; trying hard

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how a character is read, then the Mandarin for marks at school.

You'll want to know: nǔlì

nǔlì — "hard-working; trying hard".

> *tā xuéxí hěn nǔlì* — She works hard at her studies.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nǔlì is built from *nǔ* and *lì* 'strength', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nuX* and *lik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with this very word and the second 'sinew'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǔlì*
- *Say it: nǔlì*, once more
- *Say it: tā xuéxí hěn nǔlì* — She works hard at her studies.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how a character is read, then the Mandarin for marks at school, then say *nǔlì* again

Before you move on

What does nǔlì mean? ("Hard-working; trying hard".) Say it once more.

Chapter 250

Hobbies

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask about hobbies and interests, and talk about novels, stories and playing chess.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 250: I can ask about hobbies and interests, and talk about novels, stories and playing chess.*

250.1 àihào — hobby

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for marks at school, then the Mandarin for hard-working.

You'll want to know: àihào

àihào — "hobby".

> *nǐ yǒu shénme àihào* — What hobbies do you have?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

àihào is built from *ài* 'to love' and *hào* 'to be fond of', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'ojH* and *xawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to cherish' and the second with this very word. The second is 好 said with a falling tone.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: àihào*
- *Say it: àihào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu shénme àihào* — What hobbies do you have?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for marks at school, then the Mandarin for hard-working, then say *àihào* again

Before you move on

What does àihào mean? ("Hobby".) Say it once more.

250.2 xìngqù — interest; interest in something

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hard-working, then the Mandarin for a hobby.

You'll want to know: xìngqù

xìngqù — "interest; interest in something".

wǒ méiyǒu xìngqù — I'm not interested.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìngqù is built from *xìng* and *qù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xingH* and *tshjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'to tend towards'; it gives no sense for the first in this tone, and its level-tone reading means 'to rise'. How the pair came to mean an interest is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìngqù*
- *Say it: xìngqù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ méiyǒu xìngqù* — I'm not interested.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hard-working, then the Mandarin for a hobby, then say *xìngqù* again

Before you move on

What does xìngqù mean? ("Interest; interest in something".) Say it once more.

250.3 小说 (xiǎoshuō) — novel; story (in a book)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hobby, then the Mandarin for an interest.

You'll want to know: 小说

小说 — *xiǎoshuō* — "novel; story (in a book)".

我喜欢读小说 *wǒ xǐhuan dú xiǎoshuō* — I like reading novels.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小说 (*xiǎoshuō*) is built from 小 'small' and 说 'to tell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *sywet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to tell'. How 'small tellings' came to mean a novel is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoshuō*
- *Say it: xiǎoshuō*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan dú xiǎoshuō* — I like reading novels.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hobby, then the Mandarin for an interest, then say *xiǎoshuō* again

Before you move on

What does 小说 mean? ("Novel; story (in a book)".) Say it once more.

250.4 gùshi — story

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an interest, then the Mandarin for a novel.

You'll want to know: gùshi

gùshi — "story".

zhège gùshi hěn yǒu yìsi — This story is really interesting.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gùshi is built from *gù* 'old' and 事 'an affair', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuH* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'old'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: gùshi*
- *Say it: gùshi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège gùshi hěn yǒu yìsi* — This story is really interesting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an interest, then the Mandarin for a novel, then say *gùshi* again

Before you move on

What does gùshi mean? (“Story”.) Say it once more.

250.5 xiàqí — to play chess

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a novel, then the Mandarin for a story.

You’ll want to know: xiàqí

xiàqí — “to play chess”.

wǒmen xiàwǔ yìqǐ xiàqí — We’re playing chess together this afternoon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàqí is built from 下 ’to go down’ and *qí* ’a board game’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’to descend’ and lists the second under another spelling of the character, quoting an older book on who first made the board game weiqi.

What you’ve built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàqí*
- *Say it: xiàqí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiàwǔ yìqǐ xiàqí* — We’re playing chess together this afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a novel, then the Mandarin for a story, then say *xiàqí* again

Before you move on

What does xiàqí mean? (“To play chess”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 251

Essays and New Characters

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count essays and stories, talk about a school essay, writing and new characters, and put mistakes right.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 251: I can count essays and stories, talk about a school essay, writing and new characters, and put mistakes right.*

251.1 piān — measure word for essays and stories

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a story, then the Mandarin for to play chess.

You'll want to know: piān

piān — "measure word for essays and stories".

> *zhè piān xiǎoshuō hěn cháng* — This story is a long one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

piān is inherited from Middle Chinese *phjien* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as a section of a book.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: piān*
- *Say it: piān*, once more
- *Say it: zhè piān xiǎoshuō hěn cháng* — This story is a long one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a story, then the Mandarin for to play chess, then say *piān* again

Before you move on

What does piān mean? ("Measure word for essays and stories".) Say it once more.

251.2 作文 (zuòwén) — essay; composition (at school)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to play chess, then the Mandarin for measure word for essays.

You'll want to know: 作文

作文 — *zuòwén* — "essay; composition (at school)".

wǒ zài xiě zuòwén — I'm writing an essay.

The new character, in pieces: 作 — seven strokes: the person piece 亻; then a short stroke falling to the left, a bar, a long vertical, and two short bars to the right of it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

作文 (*zuòwén*) is built from 作 'to make' and 文 'writing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsak* and *mjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to do' and 'to rise', and the second 'a piece of writing'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòwén*
- *Say it: zuòwén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài xiě zuòwén* — I'm writing an essay.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to play chess, then the Mandarin for measure word for essays, then say *zuòwén* again

Before you move on

What does 作文 mean? ("Essay; composition (at school)".) Say it once more.

251.3 作 — the person piece, then a post with two short bars

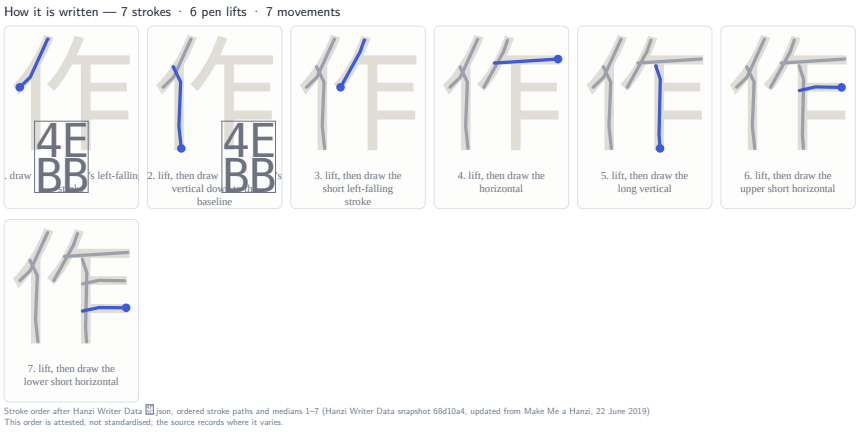
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zuòwén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  做 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zuò*, *nǐ*

Script — the person piece, then a post with two short bars



How 作 is written, stroke by stroke

作

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, 亻, two strokes, as in 你 and 做: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical down to the foot.

The right piece, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left at the top. A bar to the right from its middle. A long vertical down from the bar to the foot. Then two short bars against the right side of the vertical, the upper one first.

2 + 5 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 作, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 作? (**Seven.**) Which other character starts with the same piece and is said zuò? (做.) What are the last two strokes? (**Two short bars on the right of the vertical.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 作, pinned stroke paths and medians.

251.4 写作 (xiězuò) — to write essays and stories; writing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for measure word for essays, then the Mandarin for a school essay.

You'll want to know: 写作

写作 — *xiězuò* — "to write essays and stories; writing".

我很喜欢写作 *wǒ hěn xǐhuan xiězuò* — I really enjoy writing.

The new character, in pieces: 写 — five strokes: a cover of a dot and a bar that turns down; under it a short bar, a stroke that comes down, turns right, turns down again and hooks, and a long bar at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

写作 (*xiězuò*) is built from 写 'to write' and 作 'to make', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjaeX* and *tsak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, among other senses, 'to copy out a book'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiězuò*
- *Say it: xiězuò*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn xǐhuan xiězuò* — I really enjoy writing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for measure word for essays, then the Mandarin for a school essay, then say *xiězuò* again

Before you move on

What does 写作 mean? ("To write essays and stories; writing".) Say it once more.

251.5 写 — a cover, then a turning hook

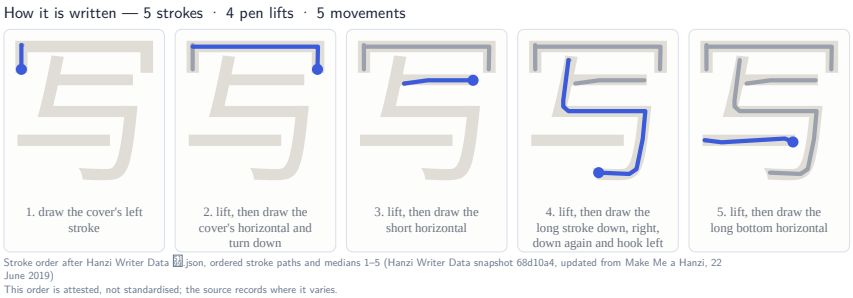
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiězuò* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  学 字

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xué*, *zì*

Script — a cover, then a turning hook



How 写 is written, stroke by stroke

写

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The cover, two strokes. A short dot on the left, then a bar that runs right and turns down, ending in a small hook: the cover of 学.

Under the cover, three strokes. A short bar in the middle. Then a stroke that starts right under the cover, comes down, turns right, turns down again and hooks to the left. Then the long bar across the foot.

2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 写, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 写? (**Five**.) Where have you made the cover before? (**On 学, under its dots**.) What comes last? (**The long bar at the foot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 写, pinned stroke paths and medians.

251.6 生字 (shēngzì) — new character; a character not yet learned

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a school essay, then the Mandarin for to write essays and stories.

You'll want to know: 生字

生字 — *shēngzì* — "new character; a character not yet learned".

这些生字我都会写 *zhèxiē shēngzì wǒ dōu huì xiě* — I can write all these new characters.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生字 (*shēngzì*) is built from 生 and 字 'a character', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *dziH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to grow'. Its sense 'raw, not yet known' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngzì*
- *Say it: shēngzì*, once more
- *Say it: zhèxiē shēngzì wǒ dōu huì xiě* — I can write all these new characters.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a school essay, then the Mandarin for to write essays and stories, then say *shēngzì* again

Before you move on

What does 生字 mean? ("New character; a character not yet learned".) Say it once more.

251.7 xiūgǎi — to revise; to correct (a piece of work)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to write essays and stories, then the Mandarin for a new character.

You'll want to know: xiūgǎi

xiūgǎi — "to revise; to correct (a piece of work)".

zhè piān zuòwén nǐ yào xiūgǎi — You'll need to revise this essay.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiūgǎi is built from *xiū* and *gǎi*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjuw* and *kojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to put in order' and 'to adorn', and the second 'to change'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiūgǎi*
- *Say it: xiūgǎi*, once more
- *Say it: zhè piān zuòwén nǐ yào xiūgǎi* — You'll need to revise this essay.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to write essays and stories, then the Mandarin for a new character, then say *xiūgǎi* again

Before you move on

What does xiūgǎi mean? ("To revise; to correct (a piece of work)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 252

Happy and Sad

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am in high spirits, how I feel, and that I am heartbroken, disappointed or satisfied.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 252: I can say I am in high spirits, how I feel, and that I am heartbroken, disappointed or satisfied.*

252.1 开心 (kāixīn) — happy; in high spirits

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a new character, then the Mandarin for to revise a piece of work.

You'll want to know: 开心

开心 — *kāixīn* — "happy; in high spirits".

> 今天我很开心 *jīntiān wǒ hěn kāixīn* — I'm in a really good mood today.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开心 (*kāixīn*) is built from 开 'to open' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): an open heart.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāixīn*
- *Say it: kāixīn*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒ hěn kāixīn* — I'm in a really good mood today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a new character, then the Mandarin for to revise a piece of work, then say *kāixīn* again

Before you move on

What does 开心 mean? ("Happy; in high spirits".) Say it once more.

252.2 gǎndào — to feel

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to revise a piece of work, then the Mandarin for in high spirits.

You'll want to know: gǎndào

gǎndào — "to feel".

wǒ gǎndào hěn kāixīn — I feel really happy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎndào is built from *gǎn* and 到 'to reach', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎndào*
- *Say it: gǎndào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎndào hěn kāixīn* — I feel really happy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to revise a piece of work, then the Mandarin for in high spirits, then say *gǎndào* again

Before you move on

What does gǎndào mean? ("To feel".) Say it once more.

252.3 shāngxīn — sad; heartbroken

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in high spirits, then the Mandarin for to feel.

You'll want to know: shāngxīn

shāngxīn — "sad; heartbroken".

tā hěn shāngxīn — He's heartbroken.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāngxīn is built from *shāng* 'to hurt' and 忄 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syang* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to harm'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāngxīn*
- *Say it: shāngxīn*, once more

- *Say it: tā hěn shāngxīn* — He's heartbroken.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in high spirits, then the Mandarin for to feel, then say *shāngxīn* again

Before you move on

What does shāngxīn mean? ("Sad; heartbroken".) Say it once more.

252.4 shīwàng — disappointed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to feel, then the Mandarin for heartbroken.

You'll want to know: shīwàng

shīwàng — "disappointed".

tā méi lái wǒ hěn shīwàng — He didn't come, and I'm disappointed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīwàng is built from *shī* 'to lose' and *wàng* 'to watch for', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to let slip' and the second 'to watch for someone's return'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīwàng*
- *Say it: shīwàng*, once more
- *Say it: tā méi lái wǒ hěn shīwàng* — He didn't come, and I'm disappointed.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to feel, then the Mandarin for heartbroken, then say *shīwàng* again

Before you move on

What does shīwàng mean? ("Disappointed".) Say it once more.

252.5 mǎnyì — satisfied; pleased

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for heartbroken, then the Mandarin for disappointed.

You'll want to know: mǎnyì

mǎnyì — "satisfied; pleased".

nǐ mǎnyì ma — Are you happy with it?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǎnyì is built from *mǎn* 'full' and *yì* 'intent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *manX* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'full' and the second 'will'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎnyì*
- *Say it: mǎnyì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ mǎnyì ma* — Are you happy with it?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for heartbroken, then the Mandarin for disappointed, then say *mǎnyì* again

Before you move on

What does mǎnyì mean? (“Satisfied; pleased”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 253

Grandparents and Relatives

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my grandparents, a child, sons and daughters, and relatives.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 253: I can talk about my grandparents, a child, sons and daughters, and relatives.*

253.1 yéye — grandpa on the father's side

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for disappointed, then the Mandarin for satisfied.

You'll want to know: yéye

yéye — "grandpa on the father's side".

> *wǒ yéye jīnnián bāshí suì* — My grandpa is eighty this year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yéye is one syllable, *yé*, said twice, the second time with no tone. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: yéye*
- *Say it: yéye*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yéye jīnnián bāshí suì* — My grandpa is eighty this year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for disappointed, then the Mandarin for satisfied, then say *yéye* again

Before you move on

What does yéye mean? ("Grandpa on the father's side".) Say it once more.

253.2 nǎinai — grandma on the father's side

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for satisfied, then the Mandarin for grandpa on the father's side.

You'll want to know: nǎinai

nǎinai — "grandma on the father's side".

nǎinai hé yéye dōu hěn hǎo — My grandma and grandpa are both well.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nǎinai is built from *nǎi*, said twice, the second time with no tone. It is inherited from Middle Chinese *nreaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which spells the character another way and glosses it 'milk', the *nǎi* of *niúnǎi*; read *nejX*, the same character is glossed as what the people of Chu called their mother. How it came to mean a father's mother is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǎinai*
- *Say it: nǎinai*, once more
- *Say it: nǎinai hé yéye dōu hěn hǎo* — My grandma and grandpa are both well.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for satisfied, then the Mandarin for grandpa on the father's side, then say *nǎinai* again

Before you move on

What does nǎinai mean? ("Grandma on the father's side".) Say it once more.

253.3 小孩 (xiǎohái) — child; kid

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grandpa on the father's side, then the Mandarin for grandma on the father's side.

You'll want to know: 小孩

小孩 — *xiǎohái* — "child; kid".

那个小孩八岁 *nàge xiǎohái bā suì* — That kid is eight.

The new character, in pieces: 孩 — nine strokes: 子 on the left, its last stroke rising; on the right a dot, a bar, a stroke that falls to the left and turns up, two strokes falling to the left, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小孩 (*xiǎohái*) is built from 小 'small' and 孩 'a child', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *hoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a newborn child'.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎohái*
- *Say it: xiǎohái*, once more
- *Say it: nàge xiǎohái bā suì* — That kid is eight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grandpa on the father's side, then the Mandarin for grandma on the father's side, then say *xiǎohái* again

Before you move on

What does 小孩 mean? ("Child; kid".) Say it once more.

253.4 孩 — 子, then a dot, a bar and four strokes

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiǎohái* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  子 小

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zǐ*, *xiǎo*

Script — 子, then a dot, a bar and four strokes

How 孩 is written, stroke by stroke

孩

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, 子, three strokes. A bar that turns down to the left, a vertical with a hook, then the last stroke: on the left of a character it rises to the right instead of lying flat.

The right piece, six strokes. A dot on top. A bar under it. A stroke that falls to the left and turns up to the right. A long stroke falling to the left. A shorter stroke falling to the left under it. Then a dot at the lower right.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 孩, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 孩? (**Nine**.) Which piece is on the left? (子.) What changes in 子 here? (**Its last stroke rises to the right**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 孩, pinned stroke paths and medians.

253.5 子女 (zǐnǚ) — sons and daughters; children

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grandma on the father's side, then the Mandarin for a kid.

You'll want to know: 子女

子女 — *zǐnǚ* — "sons and daughters; children".

他们有三个子女 *tāmen yǒu sān ge zǐnǚ* — They have three children.

Two third tones meet in this word: zǐ is said with a rising tone before nǚ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

子女 (*zǐnǚ*) is built from 子 'a son' and 女 'a daughter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsiX* and *nrjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǐnǚ*
- *Say it: zǐnǚ*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen yǒu sān ge zǐnǚ* — They have three children.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grandma on the father's side, then the Mandarin for a kid, then say *zǐnǚ* again

Before you move on

What does 子女 mean? ("Sons and daughters; children".) Say it once more.

253.6 qīnqi — relative; family member

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a kid, then the Mandarin for sons and daughters.

You'll want to know: qīnqi

qīnqi — "relative; family member".

tā shì wǒ de qīnqi — He's a relative of mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīnqi is built from *qīn* 'close' and *qi*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshin* and *tshek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to love' and 'near', and the second with this very word. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīnqi*
- *Say it: qīnqi*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ de qīnqi* — He's a relative of mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a kid, then the Mandarin for sons and daughters, then say *qīnqi* again

Before you move on

What does qīnqi mean? ("Relative; family member".) Say it once more.

253.7 Looking back: from A New Term to Grandparents and Relatives

Say the Mandarin for a school term and a year group at school.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a school term, a year group at school, a head teacher, senior high school, a pupil's parent
- *Say it:* to prepare a lesson, to finish school for the day, how a character is read, marks at school, hard-working
- *Say it:* a hobby, an interest, a novel, a story, to play chess

- *Say it:* measure word for essays, a school essay, to write essays and stories, a new character, to revise a piece of work
- *Say it:* in high spirits, to feel, heartbroken, disappointed, satisfied
- *Say it:* grandpa on the father's side, grandma on the father's side, a kid, sons and daughters, a relative
- *Read it:* 校 高 读 作 写 孩 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A school term? (学期, *xuéqī.*) A year group at school? (*niánjí.*) A head teacher? (校长, *xiàozhǎng.*) Senior high school? (高中, *gāozhōng.*) A pupil's parent? (家长, *jiāzhǎng.*) To prepare a lesson? (*yùxí.*) To finish school for the day? (*fàngxué.*) How a character is read? (读音, *dúyīn.*) Marks at school? (*chéngjì.*) Hard-working? (*nǔlì.*) A hobby? (*àihào.*) An interest? (*xìngqù.*) A novel? (小说, *xiǎoshuō.*) A story? (*gùshi.*) To play chess? (*xiàqí.*) Measure word for essays? (*piān.*) A school essay? (作文, *zuòwén.*) To write essays and stories? (写作, *xiězuò.*) A new character? (生字, *shēngzì.*) To revise a piece of work? (*xiūgǎi.*) In high spirits? (开心, *kāixīn.*) To feel? (*gǎndào.*) Heartbroken? (*shāngxīn.*) Disappointed? (*shīwàng.*) Satisfied? (*mǎnyì.*) Grandpa on the father's side? (*yéye.*) Grandma on the father's side? (*nǎinai.*) A kid? (小孩, *xiǎohái.*) Sons and daughters? (子女, *zǐnǚ.*) A relative? (*qīnqi.*)

Chapter 254

Born and Married

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a baby has been born, someone has married or finished school, and talk about a wedding and daily life.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 254: I can say a baby has been born, someone has married or finished school, and talk about a wedding and daily life.*

254.1 出生 (chūshēng) — to be born

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sons and daughters, then the Mandarin for a relative.

You'll want to know: 出生

出生 — *chūshēng* — "to be born".

> 他的孩子出生了 *tā de háizi chūshēng le* — His baby has been born.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出生 (*chūshēng*) is built from 出 'to come out' and 生 'to grow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūshēng*
- *Say it: chūshēng*, once more
- *Say it: tā de háizi chūshēng le* — His baby has been born.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sons and daughters, then the Mandarin for a relative, then say *chūshēng* again

Before you move on

What does 出生 mean? ("To be born".) Say it once more.

254.2 jiéhūn — to get married

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a relative, then the Mandarin for to be born.

You'll want to know: jiéhūn

jiéhūn — "to get married".

wǒ gēge jiéhūn le — My brother has got married.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiéhūn is built from *jié* 'to tie' and *hūn* 'marriage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ket* and *xwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tie' and the second 'marriage'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiéhūn*
- *Say it: jiéhūn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēge jiéhūn le* — My brother has got married.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a relative, then the Mandarin for to be born, then say *jiéhūn* again

Before you move on

What does jiéhūn mean? ("To get married".) Say it once more.

254.3 bìyè — to graduate; to finish school

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be born, then the Mandarin for to get married.

You'll want to know: bìyè

bìyè — "to graduate; to finish school".

tā míngnián dàxué bìyè — She finishes university next year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bìyè is built from *bì* 'to finish' and *yè* 'a task', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjit* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to end' and the second 'an affair'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìyè*
- *Say it: bìyè*, once more

- *Say it: tā míngnián dàxué bìyè* — She finishes university next year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be born, then the Mandarin for to get married, then say *bìyè* again

Before you move on

What does bìyè mean? ("To graduate; to finish school".) Say it once more.

254.4 hūnlǐ — wedding

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get married, then the Mandarin for to graduate.

You'll want to know: hūnlǐ

hūnlǐ — "wedding".

wǒmen qù cānjiā tāmen de hūnlǐ — We're going to their wedding.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hūnlǐ is built from *hūn* 'marriage' and *lǐ* 'a rite', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwon* and *lejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older dictionary for the second: what is done to serve the spirits.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: hūnlǐ*
- *Say it: hūnlǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù cānjiā tāmen de hūnlǐ* — We're going to their wedding.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get married, then the Mandarin for to graduate, then say *hūnlǐ* again

Before you move on

What does hūnlǐ mean? ("Wedding".) Say it once more.

254.5 shēnghuó — life; daily life

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to graduate, then the Mandarin for a wedding.

You'll want to know: shēnghuó

shēnghuó — "life; daily life".

zhèr de shēnghuó hěn hǎo — Life here is good.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēnghuó is built from 生 'to grow' and *huó* 'alive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *hwat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'not dead'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnghuó*
- *Say it: shēnghuó*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de shēnghuó hěn hǎo* — Life here is good.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to graduate, then the Mandarin for a wedding, then say *shēnghuó* again

Before you move on

What does shēnghuó mean? ("Life; daily life".) Say it once more.

Chapter 255

A Part-Time Job

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a part-time job, pay, colleagues, working late and the boss.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 255: I can talk about a part-time job, pay, colleagues, working late and the boss.*

255.1 打工 (dǎgōng) — to work part-time; to have a part-time job

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a wedding, then the Mandarin for daily life.

You'll want to know: 打工

打工 — *dǎgōng* — "to work part-time; to have a part-time job".

> 他晚上打工 *tā wǎnshang dǎgōng* — He works a part-time job in the evenings.

The new character, in pieces: 工 — three strokes: a short bar, a vertical down from its middle, and a long bar across the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

打工 (*dǎgōng*) is built from 打 'to strike' and 工 'work', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike' and the second 'skill'. Middle Chinese *taengX* would regularly give dǎng; dǎ is irregular. How the pair came to mean casual work is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎgōng*
- *Say it: dǎgōng*, once more
- *Say it: tā wǎnshang dǎgōng* — He works a part-time job in the evenings.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a wedding, then the Mandarin for daily life, then say *dǎgōng* again

Before you move on

What does 打工 mean? ("To work part-time; to have a part-time job".) Say it once more.

255.2 工 — two bars and a post

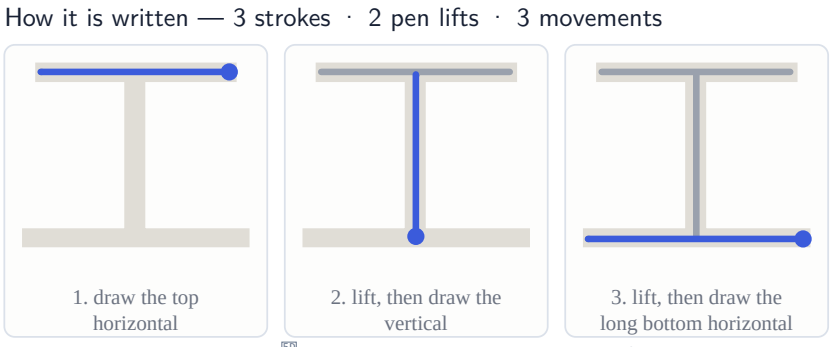
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dǎgōng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  在 打

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zài*, *dǎ*

Script — two bars and a post



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 50 25.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 工 is written, stroke by stroke

工

One piece, three strokes, top to bottom.

A short bar across the top.

A vertical down from the middle of the bar. It starts at the bar and does not cross it.

A long bar across the foot, longer than the top one, closing the vertical.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 工, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 工? (**Three**.) Which bar is longer? (**The one at the foot**.) Does the vertical cross the top bar? (**No, it starts there**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 工, pinned stroke paths and medians.

255.3 gōngzī — pay; wages

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for daily life, then the Mandarin for to work part-time.

You'll want to know: gōngzī

gōngzī — "pay; wages".

zhège gōngzuò de gōngzī hěn gāo — This job pays well.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngzī is built from 工 'work' and *zī* 'goods', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *tsij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'goods' and 'to help'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngzī*
- *Say it: gōngzī*, once more
- *Say it: zhège gōngzuò de gōngzī hěn gāo* — This job pays well.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for daily life, then the Mandarin for to work part-time, then say *gōngzī* again

Before you move on

What does gōngzī mean? ("Pay; wages".) Say it once more.

255.4 同事 (tóngshì) — colleague

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to work part-time, then the Mandarin for wages.

You'll want to know: 同事

同事 — *tóngshì* — "colleague".

> 他是我的同事我们一起工作 *tā shì wǒ de tóngshì wǒmen yìqǐ gōngzuò* — He's a colleague of mine; we work together.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

同事 (*tóngshì*) is built from 同 'the same' and 事 'affairs', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwng* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'together': people who share the work.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóngshì*
- *Say it: tóngshì*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ de tóngshì wǒmen yìqǐ gōngzuò* — He's a colleague of mine; we work together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to work part-time, then the Mandarin for wages, then say *tóngshì* again

Before you move on

What does 同事 mean? ("Colleague".) Say it once more.

255.5 jiābān — to work overtime

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for wages, then the Mandarin for a colleague.

You'll want to know: jiābān

jiābān — "to work overtime".

jīntiān wǒ yào jiābān — I have to work late today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiābān is built from *jiā* 'to add' and *bān*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *paen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to increase' and quotes an older dictionary for the second, 'to divide jade'. The sense 'a shift at work' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiābān*
- *Say it: jiābān*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒ yào jiābān* — I have to work late today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for wages, then the Mandarin for a colleague, then say *jiābān* again

Before you move on

What does jiābān mean? ("To work overtime".) Say it once more.

255.6 lǎobǎn — boss; owner (of a business)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a colleague, then the Mandarin for to work overtime.

You'll want to know: lǎobǎn

lǎobǎn — "boss; owner (of a business)".

> *wǒ de lǎobǎn rén hěn hǎo* — My boss is a nice person.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: lǎo is said with a rising tone before bǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǎobǎn is built from *lǎo* 'old' and *bǎn* 'a board', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lawX* and *paenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How the pair came to mean the boss is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǎobǎn*
- *Say it: lǎobǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de lǎobǎn rén hěn hǎo* — My boss is a nice person.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a colleague, then the Mandarin for to work overtime, then say *lǎobǎn* again

Before you move on

What does lǎobǎn mean? ("Boss; owner (of a business)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 256

What Do You Think?

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what someone thinks, give my view, say how things look, say perhaps, and say we are different.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 256: I can ask what someone thinks, give my view, say how things look, say perhaps, and say we are different.*

256.1 rènwéi — to think; to hold a view

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to work overtime, then the Mandarin for the boss.

You'll want to know: rènwéi

rènwéi — "to think; to hold a view".

> *nǐ rènwéi zěnmeyàng* — What do you think?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rènwéi is built from *rèn* 'to know' and *wéi*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyinH* and *hjwe* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to know' and the second 'to make'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: rènwéi*
- *Say it: rènwéi*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ rènwéi zěnmeyàng* — What do you think?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to work overtime, then the Mandarin for the boss, then say *rènwéi* again

Before you move on

What does rènwéi mean? ("To think; to hold a view".) Say it once more.

256.2 kànfǎ — view; opinion

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the boss, then the Mandarin for to hold a view.

You'll want to know: kànfǎ

kànfǎ — "view; opinion".

wǒmen de kànfǎ yíyàng — We see it the same way.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kànfǎ is built from 看 'to look' and *fǎ* 'a rule, a way', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khanH* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a rule': a way of looking.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: kànfǎ*
- *Say it: kànfǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de kànfǎ yíyàng* — We see it the same way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the boss, then the Mandarin for to hold a view, then say *kànfǎ* again

Before you move on

What does kànfǎ mean? ("View; opinion".) Say it once more.

256.3 看来 (kànlai) — it seems; it looks as if

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hold a view, then the Mandarin for a point of view.

You'll want to know: 看来

看来 — *kànlai* — "it seems; it looks as if".

看来他今天不来了 *kànlai tā jīntiān bù lái le* — It looks as if he isn't coming today.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

看来 (*kànlai*) is built from 看 'to look' and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khanH* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: kànlai*
- *Say it: kànlai*, once more

- *Say it: kànlai tā jīntiān bù lái le* — It looks as if he isn't coming today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hold a view, then the Mandarin for a point of view, then say *kànlai* again

Before you move on

What does 看来 mean? ("It seems; it looks as if".) Say it once more.

256.4 yěxǔ — it may be that; perhaps

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a point of view, then the Mandarin for it looks as if.

You'll want to know: yěxǔ

yěxǔ — "it may be that; perhaps".

yěxǔ tā wàng le — Maybe he forgot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: yě is said with a rising tone before xǔ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yěxǔ is built from 也 'also' and *xǔ* 'to allow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yaeX* and *xjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a particle that closes a sentence and the second 'to permit'. How the pair came to mean perhaps is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: yěxǔ*
- *Say it: yěxǔ*, once more

- *Say it: yěxǔ tā wàng le* — Maybe he forgot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a point of view, then the Mandarin for it looks as if, then say *yěxǔ* again

Before you move on

What does yěxǔ mean? ("It may be that; perhaps".) Say it once more.

256.5 不同 (bùtóng) — different

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for it looks as if, then the Mandarin for it may be that.

You'll want to know: 不同

不同 — *bùtóng* — "different".

我们两个人很不同 *wǒmen liǎng ge rén hěn bùtóng* — The two of us are very different.

Tone: 不 keeps its own falling tone here, bù, because tóng after it is a rising tone, not a falling one.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不同 (*bùtóng*) is built from 不 'not' and 同 'the same', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *duwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùtóng*
- *Say it: bùtóng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen liǎng ge rén hěn bùtóng* — The two of us are very different.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for it looks as if, then the Mandarin for it may be that, then say *bùtóng* again

Before you move on

What does 不同 mean? ("Different".) Say it once more.

Chapter 257

Music and Shows

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about musical instruments, drumming, performing and singers, and say people clapped.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 257: I can talk about musical instruments, drumming, performing and singers, and say people clapped.*

257.1 yuèqì — musical instrument

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for it may be that, then the Mandarin for different.

You'll want to know: yuèqì

yuèqì — "musical instrument".

> *nǐ huì tán shénme yuèqì* — What instrument can you play?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuèqì is built from 乐 'music' and *qì* 'a vessel', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngaewk* and *khijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'music' and the second 'a dish, a vessel'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuèqì*
- *Say it: yuèqì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ huì tán shénme yuèqì* — What instrument can you play?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for it may be that, then the Mandarin for different, then say *yuèqì* again

Before you move on

What does yuèqì mean? ("Musical instrument".) Say it once more.

257.2 dǎgǔ — to play the drums

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for different, then the Mandarin for a musical instrument.

You'll want to know: dǎgǔ

dǎgǔ — "to play the drums".

wǒ dìdi huì dǎgǔ — My little brother can play the drums.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: dǎ is said with a rising tone before gǔ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎgǔ is built from 打 'to strike' and *gǔ* 'a drum', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *kuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older dictionary for the second, 'to beat a drum'. Middle Chinese *taengX* would regularly give dǎng; dǎ is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎgǔ*
- *Say it: dǎgǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dìdi huì dǎgǔ* — My little brother can play the drums.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for different, then the Mandarin for a musical instrument, then say *dǎgǔ* again

Before you move on

What does dǎgǔ mean? ("To play the drums".) Say it once more.

257.3 yǎnchū — to perform on stage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a musical instrument, then the Mandarin for to play the drums.

You'll want to know: yǎnchū

yǎnchū — "to perform on stage".

jīntiān wǎnshang tāmen yǎnchū — They're performing tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎnchū is built from *yǎn* and 出 'to come out', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yenX* and *tsyhwit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'wide' and 'water flowing far'. The sense 'to perform' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnchū*
- *Say it: yǎnchū*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǎnshang tāmen yǎnchū* — They're performing tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a musical instrument, then the Mandarin for to play the drums, then say *yǎnchū* again

Before you move on

What does yǎnchū mean? ("To perform on stage".) Say it once more.

257.4 gēshǒu — singer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to play the drums, then the Mandarin for to perform on stage.

You'll want to know: gēshǒu

gēshǒu — "singer".

tā shì wǒ zuì xǐhuan de gēshǒu — He's my favourite singer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēshǒu is built from *gē* 'a song' and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ka* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older book for the first: the voice of people is called song. A hand here is someone skilled at a thing; that sense is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēshǒu*
- *Say it: gēshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ zuì xǐhuan de gēshǒu* — He's my favourite singer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to play the drums, then the Mandarin for to perform on stage, then say *gēshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does gēshǒu mean? ("Singer".) Say it once more.

257.5 gǔzhǎng — to clap; to applaud

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to perform on stage, then the Mandarin for a singer.

You'll want to know: gǔzhǎng

gǔzhǎng — "to clap; to applaud".

dàjiā dōu gǔzhǎng le — Everyone clapped.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: gǔ is said with a rising tone before zhǎng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǔzhǎng is built from *gǔ* 'a drum' and *zhǎng* 'the palm of the hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *tsyangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older dictionary for the first, 'to beat a drum', and glosses the second 'the palm'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔzhǎng*
- *Say it: gǔzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu gǔzhǎng le* — Everyone clapped.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to perform on stage, then the Mandarin for a singer, then say *gǔzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does gǔzhǎng mean? ("To clap; to applaud".) Say it once more.

Chapter 258

Warm-Hearted

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that someone is friendly, warm-hearted, patient or witty, and talk about their personality.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 258: I can say that someone is friendly, warm-hearted, patient or witty, and talk about their personality.*

258.1 yǒuhǎo — friendly

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a singer, then the Mandarin for to applaud.

You'll want to know: yǒuhǎo

yǒuhǎo — "friendly".

> *zhèr de rén hěn yǒuhǎo* — People here are very friendly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: yǒu is said with a rising tone before hǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒuhǎo is built from *yǒu* 'a friend' and 好 'good', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'a friend'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒuhǎo*
- *Say it: yǒuhǎo*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de rén hěn yǒuhǎo* — People here are very friendly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a singer, then the Mandarin for to applaud, then say *yǒuhǎo* again

Before you move on

What does yǒuhǎo mean? ("Friendly".) Say it once more.

258.2 热心 (rèxīn) — warm-hearted; eager to help

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to applaud, then the Mandarin for friendly.

You'll want to know: 热心

热心 — *rèxīn* — "warm-hearted; eager to help".

我们的校长很热心 *wǒmen de xiàozhǎng hěn rèxīn* — Our head teacher is very warm-hearted.

The new character, in pieces: 热 — ten strokes: the hand piece of 打, three strokes; beside it a stroke falling to the left, a bar that turns down and hooks up, and a dot; then four dots along the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

热心 (*rèxīn*) is built from 热 'hot' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyet* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as burning, as with fire.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: rèxīn*
- *Say it: rèxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de xiàozhǎng hěn rèxīn* — Our head teacher is very warm-hearted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to applaud, then the Mandarin for friendly, then say *rèxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 热心 mean? ("Warm-hearted; eager to help".) Say it once more.

258.3 热 — the hand piece and a hooked bend, over four dots

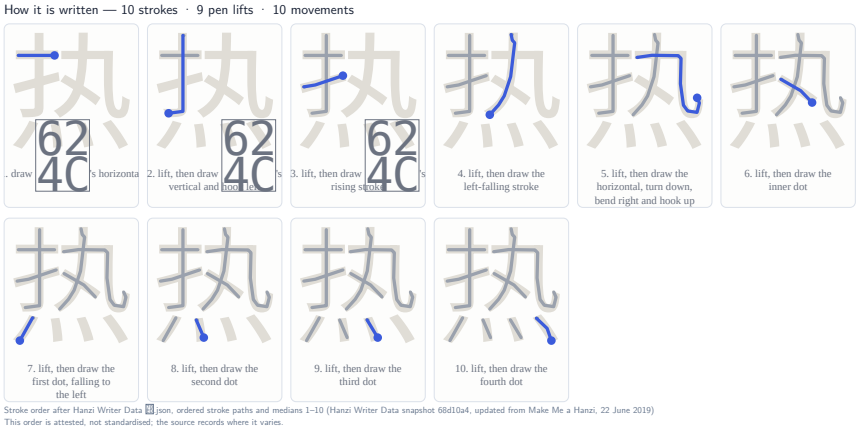
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *rèxīn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  打 心

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dǎ*, *xīn*

Script — the hand piece and a hooked bend, over four dots



How 热 is written, stroke by stroke

热

Three pieces: two side by side on top, and a row of dots under them.

The top left piece, three strokes, the hand piece of 扌: a short bar, a vertical with a hook, then a stroke rising to the right across it.

The top right piece, three strokes. A stroke falling to the left. A bar that runs right, turns down, bends out to the right and hooks up. Then a dot inside.

The foot, four dots, left to right: the first leans to the left, the other three to the right.

3 + 3 + 4 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 热, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 热? (**Ten**.) Which piece comes first? (**The hand piece of 打**.) What runs along the foot? (**Four dots**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 热, pinned stroke paths and medians.

258.4 nàixīn — patient with people

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for friendly, then the Mandarin for eager to help.

You'll want to know: nàixīn

nàixīn — "patient with people".

lǎoshī hěn nàixīn — The teacher is very patient.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nàixīn is built from *nài* 'to endure' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nojH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to bear'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: nàixīn*
- *Say it: nàixīn*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī hěn nàixīn* — The teacher is very patient.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for friendly, then the Mandarin for eager to help, then say *nàixīn* again

Before you move on

What does nàixīn mean? ("Patient with people".) Say it once more.

258.5 yōumò — humorous; witty (of a person)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for eager to help, then the Mandarin for patient with people.

You'll want to know: yōumò

yōumò — "humorous; witty (of a person)".

wǒ bàba hěn yōumò — My dad has a great sense of humour.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yōumò is usually traced to English *humour*, written with two characters whose sounds come close to it, *yōu* 'deep' and *mò* 'silent'; who first wrote it this way is not documented in what we can open.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yōumò*
- *Say it: yōumò*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba hěn yōumò* — My dad has a great sense of humour.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for eager to help, then the Mandarin for patient with people, then say *yōumò* again

Before you move on

What does yōumò mean? ("Humorous; witty (of a person)".) Say it once more.

258.6 xìnggé — personality; character

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for patient with people, then the Mandarin for witty.

You'll want to know: xìnggé

xìnggé — "personality; character".

wǒ xǐhuan tā de xìnggé — I like his personality.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìnggé is built from *xìng* 'nature' and *gé* 'a pattern', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjengH* and *kaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'nature and conduct' and the second 'a model' and 'a measure'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìnggé*
- *Say it: xìnggé*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan tā de xìnggé* — I like his personality.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for patient with people, then the Mandarin for witty, then say *xìnggé* again

Before you move on

What does xìnggé mean? ("Personality; character".) Say it once more.

Chapter 259

What Do You Do?

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what someone does for a living and name an author, a lawyer, a journalist and an electrician.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 259: I can ask what someone does for a living and name an author, a lawyer, a journalist and an electrician.*

259.1 zhíyè — occupation; profession

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for witty, then the Mandarin for personality.

You'll want to know: zhíyè

zhíyè — "occupation; profession".

> *nǐ de zhíyè shì shénme* — What do you do for a living?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhíyè is built from *zhí* 'a duty' and *yè* 'a task', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyik* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes two older dictionaries for the first: 'to be in charge' and 'work'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíyè*
- *Say it: zhíyè*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de zhíyè shì shénme* — What do you do for a living?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for witty, then the Mandarin for personality, then say *zhíyè* again

Before you move on

What does zhíyè mean? ("Occupation; profession".) Say it once more.

259.2 作家 (zuòjiā) — writer; author

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for personality, then the Mandarin for an occupation.

You'll want to know: 作家

作家 — *zuòjiā* — "writer; author".

他是作家写了十本书 *tā shì zuòjiā xiěle shí běn shū* — He's an author and has written ten books.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

作家 (*zuòjiā*) is built from 作 'to make' and 家, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsak* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a dwelling'. 家 also names a master of a craft, a sense the dictionary does not give, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòjiā*
- *Say it: zuòjiā*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì zuòjiā xiěle shí běn shū* — He's an author and has written ten books.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for personality, then the Mandarin for an occupation, then say *zuòjiā* again

Before you move on

What does 作家 mean? ("Writer; author".) Say it once more.

259.3 lǜshī — lawyer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an occupation, then the Mandarin for an author.

You'll want to know: lǜshī

lǜshī — "lawyer".

wǒ jiějie shì lǜshī — My sister is a lawyer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǜshī is built from *lǜ* 'the law' and *shī* 'a master', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lwit* and *srij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the law' and the second 'a model'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǜshī*
- *Say it: lǜshī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiějie shì lǜshī* — My sister is a lawyer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an occupation, then the Mandarin for an author, then say *lǜshī* again

Before you move on

What does lǜshī mean? ("Lawyer".) Say it once more.

259.4 jìzhě — journalist; reporter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an author, then the Mandarin for a lawyer.

You'll want to know: jìzhě

jìzhě — "journalist; reporter".

tā shì yí ge jìzhě — He's a journalist.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìzhě is built from *jì* 'to record' and *zhě* 'one who', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kiH* and *tsyaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to note down' and calls the second a particle.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìzhě*
- *Say it: jìzhě*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì yí ge jìzhě* — He's a journalist.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an author, then the Mandarin for a lawyer, then say *jìzhě* again

Before you move on

What does jìzhě mean? ("Journalist; reporter".) Say it once more.

259.5 电工 (diàngōng) — electrician

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a lawyer, then the Mandarin for a journalist.

You'll want to know: 电工

电工 — *diàngōng* — "electrician".

他是电工 *tā shì diàngōng* — He's an electrician.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

电工 (*diàngōng*) is built from 电 'electricity' and 工 'a worker', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'lightning'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: diàngōng*
- *Say it: diàngōng*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì diàngōng* — He's an electrician.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a lawyer, then the Mandarin for a journalist, then say *diàngōng* again

Before you move on

What does 电工 mean? ("Electrician".) Say it once more.

259.6 Looking back: from Born and Married to What Do You Do?

Say the Mandarin for to be born and to get married.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to be born, to get married, to graduate, a wedding, daily life
- *Say it:* to work part-time, wages, a colleague, to work overtime, the boss
- *Say it:* to hold a view, a point of view, it looks as if, it may be that, different
- *Say it:* a musical instrument, to play the drums, to perform on stage, a singer, to applaud
- *Say it:* friendly, eager to help, patient with people, witty, personality
- *Say it:* an occupation, an author, a lawyer, a journalist, an electrician
- *Read it:* 工 热 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To be born? (出生, *chūshēng.*) To get married? (*jiéhūn.*) To graduate? (*bìyè.*) A wedding? (*hūnlǐ.*) Daily life? (*shēnghuó.*) To work part-time? (打工, *dǎgōng.*) Wages? (*gōngzī.*) A colleague? (同事, *tóngshì.*) To work overtime? (*jiābān.*) The boss? (*lǎobǎn.*) To hold a view? (*rènwéi.*) A point of view? (*kànfǎ.*) It looks as if? (看来, *kànlai.*) It may be that? (*yěxǔ.*) Different? (不同, *bùtóng.*) A musical instrument? (*yuèqì.*) To play the drums? (*dǎgǔ.*) To perform on stage? (*yǎnchū.*) A singer? (*gēshǒu.*) To applaud?

(*gǔzhǎng.*) Friendly? (*yǒuhǎo.*) Eager to help? (热心, *rèxīn.*) Patient with people? (*nàixīn.*) Witty? (*yōumò.*) Personality? (*xìnggé.*) An occupation? (*zhíyè.*) An author? (作家, *zuòjiā.*) A lawyer? (*lǜshī.*) A journalist? (*jìzhě.*) An electrician? (电工, *diàngōng.*)

Chapter 260

What I Can Do

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about ability, what someone can do, an expert, technique and making progress.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 260: I can talk about ability, what someone can do, an expert, technique and making progress.*

260.1 nénglì — ability

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a journalist, then the Mandarin for an electrician.

You'll want to know: nénglì

nénglì — "ability".

> *tā hěn yǒu nénglì* — He's very capable.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nénglì is built from 能 'able' and *lì* 'strength', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nong* and *lik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'skilled' and the second 'sinew'.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nénglì*
- *Say it: nénglì*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn yǒu nénglì* — He's very capable.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a journalist, then the Mandarin for an electrician, then say *nénglì* again

Before you move on

What does nénglì mean? ("Ability".) Say it once more.

260.2 本事 (běnshi) — skill; what someone is capable of

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an electrician, then the Mandarin for ability.

You'll want to know: 本事

本事 — *běnshi* — "skill; what someone is capable of".

这个人很有本事 *zhège rén hěn yǒu běnshi* — This man can turn his hand to anything.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

本事 (*běnshi*) is built from 本 'the root' and 事 'affairs', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwonX* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the root' and 'the beginning'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: běnshi*
- *Say it: běnshi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège rén hěn yǒu běnshi* — This man can turn his hand to anything.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an electrician, then the Mandarin for ability, then say *běnshi* again

Before you move on

What does 本事 mean? ("Skill; what someone is capable of".) Say it once more.

260.3 高手 (gāoshǒu) — expert; master (at something)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ability, then the Mandarin for what someone is capable of.

You'll want to know: 高手

高手 — *gāoshǒu* — "expert; master (at something)".

做饭他是高手 *zuòfàn tā shì gāoshǒu* — When it comes to cooking, he's an expert.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

高手 (*gāoshǒu*) is built from 高 'high' and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a hand of a high level.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāoshǒu*
- *Say it: gāoshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: zuòfàn tā shì gāoshǒu* — When it comes to cooking, he's an expert.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ability, then the Mandarin for what someone is capable of, then say *gāoshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 高手 mean? ("Expert; master (at something)".) Say it once more.

260.4 jìshù — skill; technique

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what someone is capable of, then the Mandarin for an expert.

You'll want to know: jìshù

jìshù — "skill; technique".

tā de jìshù hěn hǎo — He's very skilled.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìshù is built from *jì* 'a craft' and *shù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjeX* and *zywit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'skill' and the second with this very word. Middle Chinese *zywit* would regularly give a rising tone, shú; the falling tone of shù is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìshù*
- *Say it: jìshù*, once more
- *Say it: tā de jìshù hěn hǎo* — He's very skilled.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what someone is capable of, then the Mandarin for an expert, then say *jìshù* again

Before you move on

What does jìshù mean? ("Skill; technique".) Say it once more.

260.5 jìnbù — to improve; to make progress

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an expert, then the Mandarin for technique.

You'll want to know: jìnbù

jìnbù — "to improve; to make progress".

nǐ de Hànyǔ jìnbù de hěn kuài — Your Chinese is improving fast.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìnbù is built from 进 'to go forward' and *bù* 'a step', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsinH* and *buH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'forward' and the second 'a pace'.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnbù*
- *Say it: jìnbù*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de Hànyǔ jìnbù de hěn kuài* — Your Chinese is improving fast.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an expert, then the Mandarin for technique, then say *jìnbù* again

Before you move on

What does jìnbù mean? ("To improve; to make progress".) Say it once more.

Chapter 261

Have You Ever?

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about experience, say I once did something, study abroad, go overseas and say whom I saw.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 261: I can talk about experience, say I once did something, study abroad, go overseas and say whom I saw.*

261.1 jīngyàn — experience; know-how

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for technique, then the Mandarin for to make progress.

You'll want to know: jīngyàn

jīngyàn — "experience; know-how".

> *tā hěn yǒu jīngyàn* — He's very experienced.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīngyàn is built from *jīng* and *yàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keng* and *ngjemH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'constant' and 'the warp of cloth', and the second 'to verify'. How the pair came to mean experience is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīngyàn*
- *Say it: jīngyàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn yǒu jīngyàn* — He's very experienced.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for technique, then the Mandarin for to make progress, then say *jīngyàn* again

Before you move on

What does jīngyàn mean? ("Experience; know-how".) Say it once more.

261.2 céngjīng — once (in the past); at one time

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make progress, then the Mandarin for know-how.

You'll want to know: céngjīng

céngjīng — "once (in the past); at one time".

wǒ céngjīng qù guo Běijīng — I've been to Beijing once.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

céngjīng is built from *céng* and *jīng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzong* and *keng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with the second, 'to pass through'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: céngjīng*
- *Say it: céngjīng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ céngjīng qù guo Běijīng* — I've been to Beijing once.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make progress, then the Mandarin for know-how, then say *céngjīng* again

Before you move on

What does céngjīng mean? ("Once (in the past); at one time".) Say it once more.

261.3 liúxué — to study abroad

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for know-how, then the Mandarin for at one time.

You'll want to know: liúxué

liúxué — "to study abroad".

wǒ xiǎng qù Zhōngguó liúxué — I'd like to go to China to study.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúxué is built from *liú* 'to stay' and 学 'to study', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stay' and 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúxué*
- *Say it: liúxué*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng qù Zhōngguó liúxué* — I'd like to go to China to study.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for know-how, then the Mandarin for at one time, then say *liúxué* again

Before you move on

What does liúxué mean? ("To study abroad".) Say it once more.

261.4 国外 (guówài) — abroad; overseas

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at one time, then the Mandarin for to study abroad.

You'll want to know: 国外

国外 — *guówài* — "abroad; overseas".

你去过国外吗 *nǐ qù guo guówài ma* — Have you ever been abroad?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

国外 (*guówài*) is built from 国 'a country' and 外 'outside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *ngwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'outside' and 'far'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: guówài*
- *Say it: guówài*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ qù guo guówài ma* — Have you ever been abroad?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at one time, then the Mandarin for to study abroad, then say *guówài* again

Before you move on

What does 国外 mean? ("Abroad; overseas".) Say it once more.

261.5 tǐyàn — to experience for yourself

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to study abroad, then the Mandarin for overseas.

You'll want to know: tǐyàn

tǐyàn — "to experience for yourself".

tāmen qù nóngcūn tǐyàn shēnghuó — They're going to the countryside to experience life there.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǐyàn is built from 体 'the body' and *yàn* 'to verify', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *ngjemH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the body' and the second 'to verify'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐyàn*
- *Say it: tǐyàn*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen qù nóngcūn tǐyàn shēnghuó* — They're going to the countryside to experience life there.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to study abroad, then the Mandarin for overseas, then say *tǐyàn* again

Before you move on

What does tǐyàn mean? ("To experience for yourself".) Say it once more.

Chapter 262

Win or Lose

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about tennis and table tennis, an opponent and beating them, and cheer someone on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 262: I can talk about tennis and table tennis, an opponent and beating them, and cheer someone on.*

262.1 wǎngqiú — tennis

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for overseas, then the Mandarin for to experience for yourself.

You'll want to know: wǎngqiú

wǎngqiú — "tennis".

> *wǒ xǐhuan wǎngqiú* — I like tennis.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǎngqiú is built from 网 'a net' and *qiú* 'a ball', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjangX* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a net' and the second 'a fine jade'; under another spelling of the second it glosses a ball of fur that is struck.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎngqiú*
- *Say it: wǎngqiú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan wǎngqiú* — I like tennis.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for overseas, then the Mandarin for to experience for yourself, then say *wǎngqiú* again

Before you move on

What does wǎngqiú mean? ("Tennis".) Say it once more.

262.2 pīngpāngqiú — table tennis; ping-pong

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to experience for yourself, then the Mandarin for tennis.

You'll want to know: pīngpāngqiú

pīngpāngqiú — "table tennis; ping-pong".

tā shì pīngpāngqiú gāoshǒu — He's a table tennis ace.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pīngpāngqiú is built from *pīngpāng*, which imitates the sound of the ball, and *qiú* 'a ball', inherited from Middle Chinese *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). No dictionary we use records an older form of the first part, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: pīngpāngqiú*
- *Say it: pīngpāngqiú*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì pīngpāngqiú gāoshǒu* — He's a table tennis ace.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to experience for yourself, then the Mandarin for tennis, then say *pīngpāngqiú* again

Before you move on

What does pīngpāngqiú mean? ("Table tennis; ping-pong".) Say it once more.

262.3 对手 (duìshǒu) — opponent; rival

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tennis, then the Mandarin for table tennis.

You'll want to know: 对手

对手 — *duìshǒu* — "opponent; rival".

他是我的对手 *tā shì wǒ de duìshǒu* — He's my opponent.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

对手 (*duìshǒu*) is built from 对 and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *twojH* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to answer' and 'to match': the hand that matches yours.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: duìshǒu*
- *Say it: duìshǒu*, once more

- *Say it: tā shì wǒ de duìshǒu* — He's my opponent.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tennis, then the Mandarin for table tennis, then say *duìshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 对手 mean? ("Opponent; rival".) Say it once more.

262.4 dǎbài — to defeat; to beat (an opponent)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for table tennis, then the Mandarin for an opponent.

You'll want to know: dǎbài

dǎbài — "to defeat; to beat (an opponent)".

wǒmen dǎbàile tāmen — We beat them.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎbài is built from 打 'to strike' and *bài*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *baejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike' and the second 'to fall to ruin by itself'. Middle Chinese *taengX* would regularly give dǎng; dǎ is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎbài*
- *Say it: dǎbài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen dǎbàile tāmen* — We beat them.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for table tennis, then the Mandarin for an opponent, then say *dǎbài* again

Before you move on

What does dǎbài mean? ("To defeat; to beat (an opponent)".) Say it once more.

262.5 jiāyóu — to cheer someone on; come on!

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an opponent, then the Mandarin for to defeat.

You'll want to know: jiāyóu

jiāyóu — "to cheer someone on; come on!".

jiāyóu wǒmen néng dǎbài tāmen — Come on, we can beat them!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāyóu is built from *jiā* 'to add' and *yóu* 'oil', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *yuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to increase' and the second 'oil'. How adding oil came to mean cheering someone on is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāyóu*
- *Say it: jiāyóu*, once more
- *Say it: jiāyóu wǒmen néng dǎbài tāmen* — Come on, we can beat them!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an opponent, then the Mandarin for to defeat, then say *jiāyóu* again

Before you move on

What does jiāyóu mean? (“To cheer someone on; come on!”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 263

Time Off Work

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the manager, say who is in charge, and ask for time off, sick leave or annual leave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 263: I can talk about the manager, say who is in charge, and ask for time off, sick leave or annual leave.*

263.1 jīnglǐ — manager

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to defeat, then the Mandarin for to cheer someone on.

You'll want to know: jīnglǐ

jīnglǐ — "manager".

> *jīnglǐ jīntiān bú zài* — The manager isn't in today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīnglǐ is built from *jīng* and *lǐ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keng* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'constant' and the second 'to put in order', and quotes an older dictionary for the second, 'to work jade'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīnglǐ*
- *Say it: jīnglǐ*, once more
- *Say it: jīnglǐ jīntiān bú zài* — The manager isn't in today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to defeat, then the Mandarin for to cheer someone on, then say *jīnglǐ* again

Before you move on

What does jīnglǐ mean? ("Manager".) Say it once more.

263.2 fùzé — to be in charge (of)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to cheer someone on, then the Mandarin for a manager.

You'll want to know: fùzé

fùzé — "to be in charge (of)".

zhège gōngzuò wǒ fùzé — I'm in charge of this job.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fùzé is built from *fù* 'to carry' and *zé* 'to demand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuwX* and *tsreak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to bear on the back' and the second 'to seek'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùzé*
- *Say it: fùzé*, once more
- *Say it: zhège gōngzuò wǒ fùzé* — I'm in charge of this job.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to cheer someone on, then the Mandarin for a manager, then say *fùzé* again

Before you move on

What does fùzé mean? ("To be in charge (of)".) Say it once more.

263.3 请假 (qǐngjià) — to ask for time off

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a manager, then the Mandarin for to be in charge.

You'll want to know: 请假

请假 — *qǐngjià* — "to ask for time off".

我明天要请假 *wǒ míngtiān yào qǐngjià* — I need to take tomorrow off.

The new character, in pieces: 假 — eleven strokes: the person piece 亻; then a narrow piece of five strokes, a short bar that turns down, a short bar, a long vertical and two short bars against it; then four strokes, a short bar that turns down, a short bar, a stroke that runs right and sweeps down to the left, and a long stroke to the right across it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

请假 (*qǐngjià*) is built from 请 'to ask' and 假 'leave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjengX* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to beg' and the second 'leave from work'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *qǐngjià*
- *Say it:* *qǐngjià*, once more
- *Say it:* *wǒ míngtiān yào qǐngjià* — I need to take tomorrow off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a manager, then the Mandarin for to be in charge, then say *qǐngjià* again

Before you move on

What does 请假 mean? ("To ask for time off".) Say it once more.

263.4 假 — the person piece, then two narrow pieces

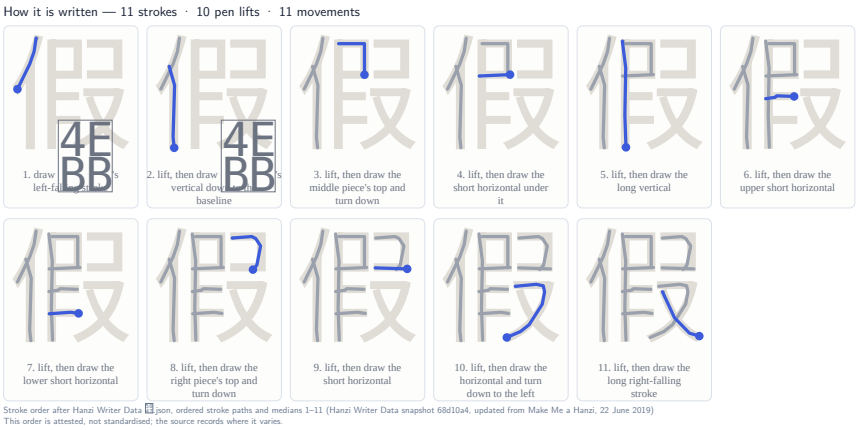
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qǐngjià* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  请 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qǐng*, *nǐ*

Script — the person piece, then two narrow pieces



How 假 *is written, stroke by stroke*

假

Three pieces, left to right.

The left piece, 亻 , two strokes: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical.

The middle piece, five strokes. A short bar that turns down at its right end. A short bar under it. A long vertical down the left side to the foot. Then two short bars against the vertical, the upper one first.

The right piece, four strokes. A short bar that turns down. A short bar under it. A stroke that runs right and sweeps down to the left. Then a long stroke falling to the right across it to the foot.

2 + 5 + 4 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 假, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 假? (**Eleven**.) Which piece comes first? (**The person piece,** 亻.) What is the last stroke? (**A long stroke falling to the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 假, pinned stroke paths and medians.

263.5 病假 (bìngjià) — sick leave

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be in charge, then the Mandarin for to ask for time off.

You'll want to know: 病假

病假 — *bìngjià* — "sick leave".

他今天请了病假 *tā jīntiān qǐngle bìngjià* — He's off sick today.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

病假 (*bìngjià*) is built from 病 'illness' and 假 'leave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaengH* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'grief' and quotes an older dictionary for 'an illness getting worse'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìngjià*
- *Say it: bìngjià*, once more
- *Say it: tā jīntiān qǐngle bìngjià* — He's off sick today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be in charge, then the Mandarin for to ask for time off, then say *bìngjià* again

Before you move on

What does 病假 mean? ("Sick leave".) Say it once more.

263.6 年假 (niánjià) — annual leave

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ask for time off, then the Mandarin for sick leave.

You'll want to know: 年假

年假 — *niánjià* — "annual leave".

我今年的年假有十天 *wǒ jīnnián de niánjià yǒu shí tiān* — I get ten days' leave this year.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

年假 (*niánjià*) is built from 年 'a year' and 假 'leave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nen* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: niánjià*
- *Say it: niánjià*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jīnnián de niánjià yǒu shí tiān* — I get ten days' leave this year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ask for time off, then the Mandarin for sick leave, then say *niánjià* again

Before you move on

What does 年假 mean? ("Annual leave".) Say it once more.

Chapter 264

Sorry, I Can't

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can turn something down politely, say it is a shame, say sorry, say I am afraid not, and say what is actually so.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 264: I can turn something down politely, say it is a shame, say sorry, say I am afraid not, and say what is actually so.*

264.1 jùjué — to refuse; to turn down

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sick leave, then the Mandarin for annual leave.

You'll want to know: jùjué

jùjué — "to refuse; to turn down".

> *tā jùjuéle wǒ* — He turned me down.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jùjué is built from *jù* 'to resist' and *jué* 'to cut off', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjoX* and *dzjwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to resist' and the second 'to break off'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: jùjué*
- *Say it: jùjué*, once more
- *Say it: tā jùjuéle wǒ* — He turned me down.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sick leave, then the Mandarin for annual leave, then say *jùjué* again

Before you move on

What does jùjué mean? ("To refuse; to turn down".) Say it once more.

264.2 kěxī — a pity; it's a shame

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for annual leave, then the Mandarin for to turn down.

You'll want to know: kěxī

kěxī — "a pity; it's a shame".

nǐ bù néng lái tài kěxī le — It's a real shame you can't come.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kěxī is built from *kě* and *xī*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *sjek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and the second 'to grudge' and, after an older dictionary, 'to grieve'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěxī*
- *Say it: kěxī*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bù néng lái tài kěxī le* — It's a real shame you can't come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for annual leave, then the Mandarin for to turn down, then say *kěxī* again

Before you move on

What does kěxī mean? ("A pity; it's a shame".) Say it once more.

264.3 bàoqiàn — sorry; regretful

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn down, then the Mandarin for a shame.

You'll want to know: bàoqiàn

bàoqiàn — "sorry; regretful".

hěn bàoqiàn wǒ míngtiān méiyǒu shíjiān — I'm very sorry, I don't have time tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàoqiàn is built from *bào* 'to hold' and *qiàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bawX* and *kheamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold'. For the second it gives a sunken mouth, and in other readings 'not eating your fill'; the sense of being sorry is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàoqiàn*
- *Say it: bàoqiàn*, once more
- *Say it: hěn bàoqiàn wǒ míngtiān méiyǒu shíjiān* — I'm very sorry, I don't have time tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn down, then the Mandarin for a shame, then say *bàoqiàn* again

Before you move on

What does bàoqiàn mean? ("Sorry; regretful".) Say it once more.

264.4 kǒngpà — I'm afraid that; probably

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a shame, then the Mandarin for sorry to say.

You'll want to know: kǒngpà

kǒngpà — "I'm afraid that; probably".

kǒngpà tā bú huì lái le — I'm afraid he won't come.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kǒngpà is built from *kǒng* and *pà*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khjowngX* and *phaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses both 'to fear'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǒngpà*
- *Say it: kǒngpà*, once more
- *Say it: kǒngpà tā bú huì lái le* — I'm afraid he won't come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a shame, then the Mandarin for sorry to say, then say *kǒngpà* again

Before you move on

What does kǒngpà mean? ("I'm afraid that; probably".) Say it once more.

264.5 qíshí — actually; as a matter of fact

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sorry to say, then the Mandarin for afraid that.

You'll want to know: qíshí

qíshí — "actually; as a matter of fact".

qíshí wǒ hěn máng — Actually, I'm really busy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qíshí is built from *qí* 'its' and *shí* 'real', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gi* and *zyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which calls the first a particle and glosses the second 'full' and 'true'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: qíshí*
- *Say it: qíshí*, once more
- *Say it: qíshí wǒ hěn máng* — Actually, I'm really busy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sorry to say, then the Mandarin for afraid that, then say *qíshí* again

Before you move on

What does qíshí mean? ("Actually; as a matter of fact".) Say it once more.

Chapter 265

Shy or Brave

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that someone is shy, brave, generous, stingy or nervous.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 265: I can say that someone is shy, brave, generous, stingy or nervous.*

265.1 hàixiū — shy; bashful

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for afraid that, then the Mandarin for as a matter of fact.

You'll want to know: hàixiū

hàixiū — "shy; bashful".

> *nàge háizi hěn hàixiū* — That child is shy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hàixiū is built from *hài* 'to harm' and *xiū* 'shame', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hajH* and *sjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to harm' and the second 'shame'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: hàixiū*
- *Say it: hàixiū*, once more
- *Say it: nàge háizi hěn hàixiū* — That child is shy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for afraid that, then the Mandarin for as a matter of fact, then say *hàixiū* again

Before you move on

What does hàixiū mean? ("Shy; bashful".) Say it once more.

265.2 yǒnggǎn — brave

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as a matter of fact, then the Mandarin for shy.

You'll want to know: yǒnggǎn

yǒnggǎn — "brave".

tā hěn yǒnggǎn — He's very brave.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: yǒng is said with a rising tone before gǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒnggǎn is built from *yǒng* and *gǎn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *youngX* and *kamX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'fierce' and the second 'brave' and 'to dare'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒnggǎn*
- *Say it: yǒnggǎn*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn yǒnggǎn* — He's very brave.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as a matter of fact, then the Mandarin for shy, then say *yǒnggǎn* again

Before you move on

What does yǒnggǎn mean? ("Brave".) Say it once more.

265.3 dàfang — generous; open-handed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for shy, then the Mandarin for brave.

You'll want to know: dàfang

dàfang — "generous; open-handed".

wǒ gēge hěn dàfang — My brother is very generous.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàfang is built from 大 'big' and *fāng* 'square', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *pjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the four quarters' and 'upright'. In the word the second loses its tone; how the pair came to mean generous is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàfang*
- *Say it: dàfang*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēge hěn dàfang* — My brother is very generous.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for shy, then the Mandarin for brave, then say *dàfang* again

Before you move on

What does dàfang mean? ("Generous; open-handed".) Say it once more.

265.4 小气 (xiǎoqì) — stingy; mean (with money)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for brave, then the Mandarin for generous.

You'll want to know: 小气

小气 — *xiǎoqì* — "stingy; mean (with money)".

他很小气 *tā hěn xiǎoqì* — He's stingy.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小气 (*xiǎoqì*) is built from 小 'small' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'breath'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoqì*
- *Say it: xiǎoqì*, once more

- *Say it: tā hěn xiǎoqì* — He's stingy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for brave, then the Mandarin for generous, then say *xiǎoqì* again

Before you move on

What does 小气 mean? ("Stingy; mean (with money)".) Say it once more.

265.5 jǐnzhāng — nervous; tense

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for generous, then the Mandarin for stingy.

You'll want to know: jǐnzhāng

jǐnzhāng — "nervous; tense".

míngtiān kǎoshì wǒ hěn jǐnzhāng — I have an exam tomorrow, and I'm nervous.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǐnzhāng is built from *jǐn* 'tight' and *zhāng* 'to stretch', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjinX* and *trjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'tightly bound' and the second 'to stretch out'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐnzhāng*
- *Say it: jǐnzhāng*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān kǎoshì wǒ hěn jǐnzhāng* — I have an exam tomorrow, and I'm nervous.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for generous, then the Mandarin for stingy, then say *jǐnzhāng* again

Before you move on

What does jǐnzhāng mean? ("Nervous; tense".) Say it once more.

265.6 Looking back: from What I Can Do to Shy or Brave

Say the Mandarin for ability and what someone is capable of.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ability, what someone is capable of, an expert, technique, to make progress
- *Say it:* know-how, at one time, to study abroad, overseas, to experience for yourself
- *Say it:* tennis, table tennis, an opponent, to defeat, to cheer someone on
- *Say it:* a manager, to be in charge, to ask for time off, sick leave, annual leave
- *Say it:* to turn down, a shame, sorry to say, afraid that, as a matter of fact
- *Say it:* shy, brave, generous, stingy, nervous
- *Read it:* 假 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Ability? (*nénglì.*) What someone is capable of? (本事, *běnshi.*) An expert? (高手, *gāoshǒu.*) Technique? (*jìshù.*) To make progress? (*jìnbù.*) Know-how? (*jīngyàn.*) At one time? (*céngjīng.*) To study abroad? (*liúxué.*) Overseas? (国外, *guówài.*) To experience for yourself? (*tǐyàn.*) Tennis? (*wǎngqiú.*) Table tennis? (*pīngpāngqiú.*) An opponent? (对手, *duìshǒu.*) To defeat? (*dǎbài.*) To cheer

someone on? (*jiāyóu.*) A manager? (*jīnglǐ.*) To be in charge? (*fùzé.*) To ask for time off? (请假, *qǐngjià.*) Sick leave? (病假, *bìngjià.*) Annual leave? (年假, *niánjià.*) To turn down? (*jùjué.*) A shame? (*kěxī.*) Sorry to say? (*bàoqiàn.*) Afraid that? (*kǒngpà.*) As a matter of fact? (*qíshí.*) Shy? (*hàixiū.*) Brave? (*yǒnggǎn.*) Generous? (*dàfang.*) Stingy? (小气, *xiǎoqì.*) Nervous? (*jǐnzhāng.*)

Chapter 266

Grown-Ups and Children

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about grown-ups, babies, boys and girls, and middle age.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 266: I can talk about grown-ups, babies, boys and girls, and middle age.*

266.1 大人 (dàren) — adult; grown-up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for stingy, then the Mandarin for nervous.

You'll want to know: 大人

大人 — *dàren* — "adult; grown-up".

> 大人和小孩都来了 *dàren hé xiǎohái dōu lái le* — The grown-ups and the children have all come.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大人 (*dàren*) is built from 大 'big' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàren*
- *Say it: dàren*, once more
- *Say it: dàren hé xiǎohái dōu lái le* — The grown-ups and the children have all come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for stingy, then the Mandarin for nervous, then say *dàren* again

Before you move on

What does 大人 mean? ("Adult; grown-up".) Say it once more.

266.2 bǎobao — baby; darling (said to a small child)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for nervous, then the Mandarin for a grown-up.

You'll want to know: bǎobao

bǎobao — "baby; darling (said to a small child)".

wǒ jiějie de bǎobao hěn kě'ài — My sister's baby is really cute.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎobao is built from *bǎo* 'a treasure', said twice, the second time with no tone. It is inherited from Middle Chinese *pawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a treasure'; its use for a baby is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎobao*
- *Say it: bǎobao*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiějie de bǎobao hěn kě'ài* — My sister's baby is really cute.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for nervous, then the Mandarin for a grown-up, then say *bǎobao* again

Before you move on

What does bǎobao mean? ("Baby; darling (said to a small child)".) Say it once more.

266.3 男孩 (nánhái) — boy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a grown-up, then the Mandarin for a baby.

You'll want to know: 男孩

男孩 — *nánhái* — "boy".

那个男孩很高 *nàge nánhái hěn gāo* — That boy is tall.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

男孩 (*nánhái*) is built from 男 'male' and 孩 'a child', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nom* and *hoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánhái*
- *Say it: nánhái*, once more

- *Say it: nàge nánhái hěn gāo* — That boy is tall.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a grown-up, then the Mandarin for a baby, then say *nánhái* again

Before you move on

What does 男孩 mean? ("Boy".) Say it once more.

266.4 女孩 (nǚhái) — girl

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a baby, then the Mandarin for a boy.

You'll want to know: 女孩

女孩 — *nǚhái* — "girl".

这个女孩很喜欢读书 *zhège nǚhái hěn xǐhuan dúshū* — This girl loves studying.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

女孩 (*nǚhái*) is built from 女 'female' and 孩 'a child', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nrjoX* and *hoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nǚhái*
- *Say it: nǚhái*, once more
- *Say it: zhège nǚhái hěn xǐhuan dúshū* — This girl loves studying.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a baby, then the Mandarin for a boy, then say *nǚhái* again

Before you move on

What does 女孩 mean? ("Girl".) Say it once more.

266.5 中年 (zhōngnián) — middle age

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a boy, then the Mandarin for a girl.

You'll want to know: 中年

中年 — *zhōngnián* — "middle age".

tā bù lǎo shì zhōngnián rén — He isn't old; he's middle-aged.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中年 (*zhōngnián*) is built from 中 'middle' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōngnián*
- *Say it: zhōngnián*, once more
- *Say it: tā bù lǎo shì zhōngnián rén* — He isn't old; he's middle-aged.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a boy, then the Mandarin for a girl, then say *zhōngnián* again

Before you move on

What does 中年 mean? ("Middle age".) Say it once more.

Chapter 267

Actors and Jokes

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about actors, TV shows and stars, and jokes that are funny.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 267: I can talk about actors, TV shows and stars, and jokes that are funny.*

267.1 yǎnyuán — actor; performer

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a girl, then the Mandarin for middle age.

You'll want to know: yǎnyuán

yǎnyuán — "actor; performer".

> *tā shì yí ge hěn hǎo de yǎnyuán* — He's a very good actor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎnyuán is built from *yǎn* and *yuán*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yenX* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'wide' and quotes an older dictionary for the second, 'a number of things'. The senses 'to perform' and 'a member' are not given there, so how the pair came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnyuán*
- *Say it: yǎnyuán*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì yí ge hěn hǎo de yǎnyuán* — He's a very good actor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a girl, then the Mandarin for middle age, then say *yǎnyuán* again

Before you move on

What does yǎnyuán mean? ("Actor; performer".) Say it once more.

267.2 jiémù — programme; TV show

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for middle age, then the Mandarin for an actor.

You'll want to know: jiémù

jiémù — "programme; TV show".

zhège jiémù hěn hǎokàn — This show is really good.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiémù is built from 节 and *mù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tset* and *mjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older dictionary for the first, 'a joint of bamboo', and glosses the second 'the eye'. How the pair came to mean a programme is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiémù*
- *Say it: jiémù*, once more
- *Say it: zhège jiémù hěn hǎokàn* — This show is really good.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for middle age, then the Mandarin for an actor, then say *jiémù* again

Before you move on

What does jiémù mean? ("Programme; TV show".) Say it once more.

267.3 明星 (míngxīng) — star; celebrity

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an actor, then the Mandarin for a TV show.

You'll want to know: 明星

明星 — *míngxīng* — "star; celebrity".

他是一个大明星 *tā shì yí ge dà míngxīng* — He's a big star.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

明星 (*míngxīng*) is built from 明 'bright' and 星 'a star', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjaeng* and *seng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'light' and the second 'a star in the sky'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngxīng*
- *Say it: míngxīng*, once more

- *Say it: tā shì yí ge dà míngxīng* — He's a big star.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an actor, then the Mandarin for a TV show, then say *míngxīng* again

Before you move on

What does 明星 mean? ("Star; celebrity".) Say it once more.

267.4 笑话 (xiàohua) — joke

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a TV show, then the Mandarin for a celebrity.

You'll want to know: 笑话

笑话 — *xiàohua* — "joke".

他说了一个笑话 *tā shuōle yí ge xiàohua* — He told a joke.

The new character, in pieces: 笑 — ten strokes: two small pieces on top, each a short stroke falling to the left, a short bar and a dot; under them a short stroke falling to the left, then 大. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

笑话 (*xiàohua*) is built from 笑 'to laugh' and 话 'talk', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewH* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'glad' and the second 'speech'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàohua*
- *Say it: xiàohua*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuōle yí ge xiàohua* — He told a joke.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a TV show, then the Mandarin for a celebrity, then say *xiàohua* again

Before you move on

What does 笑话 mean? (“Joke”.) Say it once more.

267.5 笑 — two small pieces over a short fall and 大

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiàohua* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

大 天

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *tiān*

Script — two small pieces over a short fall and 大

How 笑 *is written, stroke by stroke*

笑

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, six strokes: two small pieces side by side, each three strokes. A short stroke falling to the left, a short bar to the right from it, then a dot under the bar. Then the same three again on the right.

The bottom piece, four strokes. A short stroke falling to the left across the top. Then 大: a long bar, a stroke falling to the left, and a stroke falling to the right.

6 + 4 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 笑, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 笑? (**Ten**.) How many small pieces sit on top? (**Two, three strokes each**.) Which character ends it? (大.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 笑, pinned stroke paths and medians.

267.6 好笑 (hǎoxiào) — funny

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a celebrity, then the Mandarin for a joke.

You'll want to know: 好笑

好笑 — *hǎoxiào* — "funny".

这个笑话很好笑 *zhège xiàohua hěn hǎoxiào* — This joke is really funny.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好笑 (*hǎoxiào*) is built from 好 'good' and 笑 'to laugh', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *sjewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): good to laugh at, the way 好吃 is good to eat.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎoxiào*
- *Say it: hǎoxiào*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xiàohua hěn hǎoxiào* — This joke is really funny.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a celebrity, then the Mandarin for a joke, then say *hǎoxiào* again

Before you move on

What does 好笑 mean? ("Funny".) Say it once more.

Chapter 268

Exams

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can sign up for an exam, talk about an oral exam, passing and the answers, and ask for an explanation.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 268: I can sign up for an exam, talk about an oral exam, passing and the answers, and ask for an explanation.*

268.1 bàomíng — to sign up; to enter (one's name)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a joke, then the Mandarin for funny.

You'll want to know: bàomíng

bàomíng — "to sign up; to enter (one's name)".

> *nǐ bàomíng le ma* — Have you signed up?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàomíng is built from *bào* 'to report' and 名 'a name', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawH* and *mjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to report'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàomíng*
- *Say it: bàomíng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bàomíng le ma* — Have you signed up?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a joke, then the Mandarin for funny, then say *bàomíng* again

Before you move on

What does bàomíng mean? ("To sign up; to enter (one's name)".) Say it once more.

268.2 口试 (kǒushì) — oral exam

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for funny, then the Mandarin for to sign up.

You'll want to know: 口试

口试 — *kǒushì* — "oral exam".

明天我们学校有口试 *míngtiān wǒmen xuéxiào yǒu kǒushì* — Our school has oral exams tomorrow.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

口试 (*kǒushì*) is built from 口 'the mouth' and 试 'a test', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuwX* and *syiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to use'. The sense 'a test' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǒushì*
- *Say it: kǒushì*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǒmen xuéxiào yǒu kǒushì* — Our school has oral exams tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for funny, then the Mandarin for to sign up, then say *kǒushì* again

Before you move on

What does 口试 mean? ("Oral exam".) Say it once more.

268.3 jígé — to pass an exam

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sign up, then the Mandarin for an oral exam.

You'll want to know: jígé

jígé — "to pass an exam".

tā kǎoshì méi jígé — He didn't pass the exam.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jígé is built from *jí* 'to reach' and *gé* 'a standard', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gip* and *kaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to reach' and the second 'a model' and 'a measure'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jígé*
- *Say it: jígé*, once more
- *Say it: tā kǎoshì méi jígé* — He didn't pass the exam.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sign up, then the Mandarin for an oral exam, then say *jígé* again

Before you move on

What does jígé mean? ("To pass an exam".) Say it once more.

268.4 dá'àn — answer to a question

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an oral exam, then the Mandarin for to pass an exam.

You'll want to know: dá'àn

dá'àn — "answer to a question".

nǐ de dá'àn duì le — Your answer is right.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dá'àn is built from *dá* 'to answer' and *àn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *top* and *'anH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to match' and the second 'a low table'. How the pair came to mean an answer is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: dá'àn*
- *Say it: dá'àn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de dá'àn duì le* — Your answer is right.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an oral exam, then the Mandarin for to pass an exam, then say *dá'àn* again

Before you move on

What does dá'àn mean? ("Answer to a question".) Say it once more.

268.5 jiěshì — to explain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pass an exam, then the Mandarin for the answer to a question.

You'll want to know: jiěshì

jiěshì — "to explain".

zhège dá'àn nǐ néng jiěshì ma — Can you explain this answer?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiěshì is built from *jiě* and *shì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keaX* and *syek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to explain' and 'to untie', and the second 'to let go' and 'to untie'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what I do.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiěshì*
- *Say it: jiěshì*, once more

- *Say it: zhège dá'àn nǐ néng jiěshì ma* — Can you explain this answer?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pass an exam, then the Mandarin for the answer to a question, then say *jiěshì* again

Before you move on

What does jiěshì mean? ("To explain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 269

When I Was Little

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I have done since childhood, what comes first, what my childhood was like, what I meant to do, and talk about toys.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 269: I can say what I have done since childhood, what comes first, what my childhood was like, what I meant to do, and talk about toys.*

269.1 从小 (cóngxiǎo) — since childhood; since I was little

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the answer to a question, then the Mandarin for to explain.

You'll want to know: 从小

从小 — *cóngxiǎo* — "since childhood; since I was little".

> 我从小喜欢看书 *wǒ cóngxiǎo xǐhuan kànshū* — I've loved books since I was little.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

从小 (*cóngxiǎo*) is built from 从 'from' and 小 'small', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjowng* and *sjewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: cóngxiǎo*
- *Say it: cóngxiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ cóngxiǎo xǐhuan kànshū* — I've loved books since I was little.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the answer to a question, then the Mandarin for to explain, then say *cóngxiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 从小 mean? ("Since childhood; since I was little".) Say it once more.

269.2 先 (xiān) — first; before anything else

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to explain, then the Mandarin for since childhood.

You'll want to know: 先

先 — *xiān* — "first; before anything else".

我们先吃饭 *wǒmen xiān chīfàn* — Let's eat first.

The new character, in pieces: 先 — six strokes: a short stroke falling to the left, a short bar, a vertical and a long bar; then 儿 at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

先 (*xiān*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *sen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'before and after'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiān*
- *Say it: xiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiān chīfàn* — Let's eat first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to explain, then the Mandarin for since childhood, then say *xiān* again

Before you move on

What does 先 mean? ("First; before anything else".) Say it once more.

269.3 先 — a cross and a long bar, over 儿

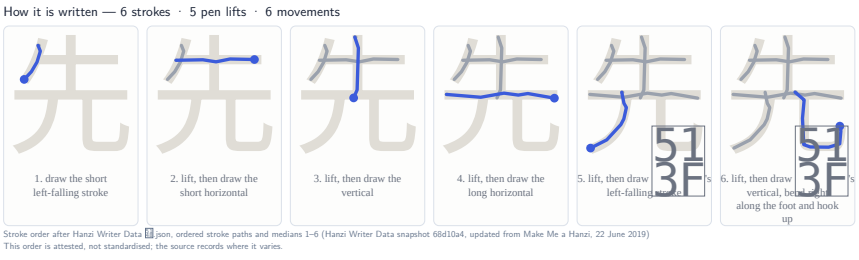
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  儿 生

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *ér*, *shēng*

Script — a cross and a long bar, over 儿



How 先 is written, stroke by stroke

先

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, four strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A short bar to the right of it. A vertical down through the bar. Then a long bar across, wider than everything above it.

The bottom piece, 儿, two strokes, as on its own: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical that bends to the right along the foot and hooks up.

4 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 先, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 先? (**Six.**) What sits at the foot? (儿.) Which bar is longer? (**The second, across the middle.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 先, pinned stroke paths and medians.

269.4 tóngnián — childhood

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for since childhood, then the Mandarin for before anything else.

You'll want to know: tóngnián

tóngnián — "childhood".

wǒ de tóngnián hěn kuàilè — I had a very happy childhood.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóngnián is built from *tóng* 'a child' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwng* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first as a young person who does not yet have a household.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóngnián*
- *Say it: tóngnián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de tóngnián hěn kuàilè* — I had a very happy childhood.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for since childhood, then the Mandarin for before anything else, then say *tóngnián* again

Before you move on

What does tóngnián mean? ("Childhood".) Say it once more.

269.5 本来 (běnlái) — originally; at first

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for before anything else, then the Mandarin for childhood.

You'll want to know: 本来

本来 — *běnlái* — "originally; at first".

我本来想先吃饭 *wǒ běnlái xiǎng xiān chīfàn* — I'd meant to eat first.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

本来 (*běnlái*) is built from 本 'the root' and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwonX* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the root' and 'the beginning'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: běnlái*
- *Say it: běnlái*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ běnlái xiǎng xiān chīfàn* — I'd meant to eat first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for before anything else, then the Mandarin for childhood, then say *běnlái* again

Before you move on

What does 本来 mean? ("Originally; at first".) Say it once more.

269.6 wánjù — toy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for childhood, then the Mandarin for originally.

You'll want to know: wánjù

wánjù — "toy".

zhège wánjù hěn yǒu yìsi — This toy is a lot of fun.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wánjù is built from *wán* 'to play' and *jù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwanH* and *gjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to toy with' and the second 'to provide'. Middle Chinese *ngwanH* would regularly give wàn; the rising tone of wán is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: wánjù*
- *Say it: wánjù*, once more
- *Say it: zhège wánjù hěn yǒu yìsi* — This toy is a lot of fun.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for childhood, then the Mandarin for originally, then say *wánjù* again

Before you move on

What does wánjù mean? (“Toy”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 270

Do You Agree?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I agree or that I am against something, that I am in favour, that I am behind someone, and that I believe them.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 270: I can say I agree or that I am against something, that I am in favour, that I am behind someone, and that I believe them.*

270.1 tóngyì — to agree

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for originally, then the Mandarin for a toy.

You'll want to know: tóngyì

tóngyì — "to agree".

> *nǐ tóngyì ma* — Do you agree?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóngyì is built from 同 'the same' and *yì* 'a mind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwng* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'will': to be of one mind.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóngyì*
- *Say it: tóngyì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ tóngyì ma* — Do you agree?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for originally, then the Mandarin for a toy, then say *tóngyì* again

Before you move on

What does tóngyì mean? ("To agree".) Say it once more.

270.2 fǎnduì — to be against; to oppose

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a toy, then the Mandarin for to agree.

You'll want to know: fǎnduì

fǎnduì — "to be against; to oppose".

wǒ bù fǎnduì — I'm not against it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fǎnduì is built from *fǎn* and 对, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjonX* and *twojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn over' and 'contrary', and the second 'to answer'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: fǎnduì*
- *Say it: fǎnduì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù fǎnduì* — I'm not against it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a toy, then the Mandarin for to agree, then say *fǎnduì* again

Before you move on

What does fǎnduì mean? ("To be against; to oppose".) Say it once more.

270.3 zànchéng — to approve of; to be in favour

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to agree, then the Mandarin for to be against.

You'll want to know: zànchéng

zànchéng — "to approve of; to be in favour".

dàjiā dōu zànchéng — Everyone's in favour.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zànchéng is built from *zàn* 'to assist' and *chéng* 'to complete', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsanH* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to assist' and the second 'to finish'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: zànchéng*
- *Say it: zànchéng*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu zànchéng* — Everyone's in favour.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to agree, then the Mandarin for to be against, then say *zànchéng* again

Before you move on

What does zànchéng mean? ("To approve of; to be in favour".) Say it once more.

270.4 zhīchí — to support; to back

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be against, then the Mandarin for to be in favour.

You'll want to know: zhīchí

zhīchí — "to support; to back".

wǒ zhīchí nǐ — I'm behind you.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhīchí is built from *zhī* and *chí* 'to hold', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsye* and *dri* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with this very word and the second 'to hold'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhīchí*
- *Say it: zhīchí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhīchí nǐ* — I'm behind you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be against, then the Mandarin for to be in favour, then say *zhīchí* again

Before you move on

What does zhīchí mean? ("To support; to back".) Say it once more.

270.5 xiāngxìn — to believe; to trust

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be in favour, then the Mandarin for to back someone up.

You'll want to know: xiāngxìn

xiāngxìn — "to believe; to trust".

wǒ xiāngxìn nǐ — I believe you.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāngxìn is built from *xiāng* 'each other' and *xìn* 'to trust', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjang* and *sinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'together' and the second 'faithful'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāngxìn*
- *Say it: xiāngxìn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiāngxìn nǐ* — I believe you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be in favour, then the Mandarin for to back someone up, then say *xiāngxìn* again

Before you move on

What does xiāngxìn mean? ("To believe; to trust".) Say it once more.

Chapter 271

Moods

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am worked up, moved, taken aback or bored, or that something is on my mind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 271: I can say I am worked up, moved, taken aback or bored, or that something is on my mind.*

271.1 jīdòng — excited; worked up

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to back someone up, then the Mandarin for to believe.

You'll want to know: jīdòng

jīdòng — "excited; worked up".

> *tā hěn jīdòng* — He's very excited.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīdòng is built from *jī* and *dòng* 'to move', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kek* and *duwngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a rushing wave' and the second 'to stir'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīdòng*
- *Say it: jīdòng*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn jīdòng* — He's very excited.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to back someone up, then the Mandarin for to believe, then say *jīdòng* again

Before you move on

What does jīdòng mean? ("Excited; worked up".) Say it once more.

271.2 gǎndòng — to move; to touch someone's heart

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to believe, then the Mandarin for worked up.

You'll want to know: gǎndòng

gǎndòng — "to move; to touch someone's heart".

zhège gùshi gǎndòngle dàjiā — This story moved everyone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎndòng is built from *gǎn* and *dòng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *duwngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move' and the second 'to stir'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎndòng*
- *Say it: gǎndòng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège gùshi gǎndòngle dàjiā* — This story moved everyone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to believe, then the Mandarin for worked up, then say *gǎndòng* again

Before you move on

What does gǎndòng mean? ("To move; to touch someone's heart".) Say it once more.

271.3 chījīng — surprised; taken aback

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for worked up, then the Mandarin for to touch someone's heart.

You'll want to know: chījīng

chījīng — "surprised; taken aback".

wǒ hěn chījīng — I'm surprised.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chījīng is built from 吃 'to eat' and *jīng* 'a fright'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to fear' and, after an older dictionary, 'a horse taking fright'; how eating a fright came to mean surprise is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chījīng*
- *Say it: chījīng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn chījīng* — I'm surprised.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for worked up, then the Mandarin for to touch someone's heart, then say *chījīng* again

Before you move on

What does chījīng mean? ("Surprised; taken aback".) Say it once more.

271.4 wúliáo — bored; boring

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to touch someone's heart, then the Mandarin for taken aback.

You'll want to know: wúliáo

wúliáo — "bored; boring".

zhège jiémù hěn wúliáo — This show is boring.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wúliáo is built from *wú* 'not to have' and *liáo*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mju* and *lew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to have or not have' and calls the second a particle. How the pair came to mean bored is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: wúliáo*
- *Say it: wúliáo*, once more
- *Say it: zhège jiémù hěn wúliáo* — This show is boring.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to touch someone's heart, then the Mandarin for taken aback, then say *wúliáo* again

Before you move on

What does wúliáo mean? ("Bored; boring".) Say it once more.

271.5 心事 (xīnshì) — something on your mind; a worry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for taken aback, then the Mandarin for bored.

You'll want to know: 心事

心事 — *xīnshì* — "something on your mind; a worry".

他今天不笑有心事 *tā jīntiān bú xiào yǒu xīnshì* — He hasn't smiled today; something's on his mind.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心事 (*xīnshì*) is built from 心 'the heart' and 事 'an affair', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnshì*

- *Say it: xīnshì*, once more
- *Say it: tā jīntiān bú xiào yǒu xīnshì* — He hasn't smiled today; something's on his mind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for taken aback, then the Mandarin for bored, then say *xīnshì* again

Before you move on

What does 心事 mean? ("Something on your mind; a worry".) Say it once more.

271.6 Looking back: from Grown-Ups and Children to Moods

Say the Mandarin for a grown-up and a baby.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a grown-up, a baby, a boy, a girl, middle age
- *Say it:* an actor, a TV show, a celebrity, a joke, funny
- *Say it:* to sign up, an oral exam, to pass an exam, the answer to a question, to explain
- *Say it:* since childhood, before anything else, childhood, originally, a toy
- *Say it:* to agree, to be against, to be in favour, to back someone up, to believe
- *Say it:* worked up, to touch someone's heart, taken aback, bored, something on your mind
- *Read it:* 笑 先 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A grown-up? (大人, *dàren.*) A baby? (*bǎobao.*) A boy? (男孩, *nánhái.*) A girl? (女孩, *nǚhái.*) Middle age? (中年, *zhōngnián.*) An

actor? (*yǎnyuán.*) A TV show? (*jiémù.*) A celebrity? (明星, *míngxīng.*) A joke? (笑话, *xiàohua.*) Funny? (好笑, *hǎoxiào.*) To sign up? (*bàomíng.*) An oral exam? (口试, *kǒushì.*) To pass an exam? (*jígé.*) The answer to a question? (*dá'àn.*) To explain? (*jiěshì.*) Since childhood? (从小, *cóngxiǎo.*) Before anything else? (先, *xiān.*) Childhood? (*tóngnián.*) Originally? (本来, *běnlái.*) A toy? (*wánjù.*) To agree? (*tóngyì.*) To be against? (*fǎnduì.*) To be in favour? (*zànchéng.*) To back someone up? (*zhīchí.*) To believe? (*xiāngxìn.*) Worked up? (*jīdòng.*) To touch someone's heart? (*gǎndòng.*) Taken aback? (*chījīng.*) Bored? (*wúliáo.*) Something on your mind? (心事, *xīnshì.*)

Chapter 272

Husband and Wife

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a husband and a wife, my grandfather on my mother's side, and an uncle and an auntie.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 272: I can talk about a husband and a wife, my grandfather on my mother's side, and an uncle and an auntie.*

272.1 qīzi — wife

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bored, then the Mandarin for something on your mind.

You'll want to know: qīzi

qīzi — "wife".

> *tā de qīzi shì yīshēng* — His wife is a doctor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīzi is built from *qī* and 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshej* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'equal'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīzi*
- *Say it: qīzi*, once more
- *Say it: tā de qīzi shì yīshēng* — His wife is a doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bored, then the Mandarin for something on your mind, then say *qīzi* again

Before you move on

What does qīzi mean? ("Wife".) Say it once more.

272.2 老公 (lǎogōng) — hubby; husband (informal)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for something on your mind, then the Mandarin for a wife.

You'll want to know: 老公

老公 — *lǎogōng* — "hubby; husband (informal)".

我老公先回家了 *wǒ lǎogōng xiān huí jiā le* — My husband has gone home ahead of me.

The new character, in pieces: 老 — six strokes: a short bar, a vertical and a long bar, then a long stroke falling to the left; under them a short stroke falling to the left and a vertical that bends right and hooks up, the right half of 比. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

老公 (*lǎogōng*) is built from 老 'old' and 公, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lawX* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'aged' and the second, among other senses, 'a father'

and 'an official'. How the pair came to mean a husband is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǎogōng*
- *Say it: lǎogōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ lǎogōng xiān huí jiā le* — My husband has gone home ahead of me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for something on your mind, then the Mandarin for a wife, then say *lǎogōng* again

Before you move on

What does 老公 mean? ("Hubby; husband (informal)".) Say it once more.

272.3 老 — a cross and a long fall, over the right half of 比

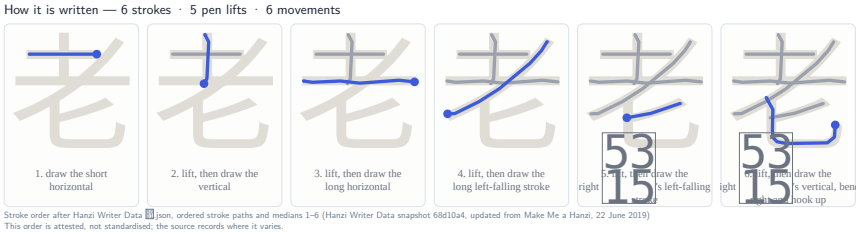
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lǎogōng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  比 公

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bǐ*, *gōng*

Script — a cross and a long fall, over the right half of 比



How 老 is written, stroke by stroke

老

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, four strokes. A short bar. A vertical down through it. A long bar under them. Then a long stroke from the upper right falling all the way to the lower left.

The bottom piece, two strokes, the right half of 比: a short stroke falling to the left, then a vertical that bends to the right along the foot and hooks up.

4 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 老, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 老? (**Six.**) Which stroke runs across the whole character? (**The long fall to the left.**) Where have you made the last two strokes? (**On the right of 比.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 老, pinned stroke paths and medians.

272.4 外公 (wàigōng) — grandpa on the mother's side

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a wife, then the Mandarin for hubby.

You'll want to know: 外公

外公 — *wàigōng* — "grandpa on the mother's side".

外公很热心 *wàigōng hěn rèxīn* — My grandpa is very warm-hearted.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

外公 (*wàigōng*) is built from 外 'outside' and 公 'a father', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second, among other senses, 'a father'.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàigōng*
- *Say it: wàigōng*, once more
- *Say it: wàigōng hěn rèxīn* — My grandpa is very warm-hearted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a wife, then the Mandarin for hubby, then say *wàigōng* again

Before you move on

What does 外公 mean? ("Grandpa on the mother's side".) Say it once more.

272.5 shūshu — uncle; father's younger brother

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hubby, then the Mandarin for grandpa on the mother's side.

You'll want to know: shūshu

shūshu — "uncle; father's younger brother".

> *wǒ shūshu shì diàngōng* — My uncle is an electrician.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shūshu is built from *shū*, said twice, the second time with no tone. It is inherited from Middle Chinese *syuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a father's youngest brother'.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūshu*
- *Say it: shūshu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shūshu shì diàngōng* — My uncle is an electrician.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hubby, then the Mandarin for grandpa on the mother's side, then say *shūshu* again

Before you move on

What does shūshu mean? ("Uncle; father's younger brother".) Say it once more.

272.6 āyí — auntie; mother's sister

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grandpa on the mother's side, then the Mandarin for an uncle.

You'll want to know: āyí

āyí — "auntie; mother's sister".

> *nàge āyí shì wǒ māma de péngyou* — That lady is a friend of my mum's.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

āyí is built from *ā*, a friendly prefix, and *yí* 'a mother's sister', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'a* and *yij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a mother's sister'. The dictionary gives the first only as 'a bend' and 'a hill', so its use before names is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I have and can do.

Your turn

- *Say it: āyí*
- *Say it: āyí*, once more
- *Say it: nàge āyí shì wǒ māma de péngyou* — That lady is a friend of my mum's.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grandpa on the mother's side, then the Mandarin for an uncle, then say *āyí* again

Before you move on

What does āyí mean? ("Auntie; mother's sister".) Say it once more.

Chapter 273

Honest and Careful

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that someone is honest, hospitable, careless, or careful and attentive.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 273: I can say that someone is honest, hospitable, careless, or careful and attentive.*

273.1 chéngshí — honest

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an uncle, then the Mandarin for an auntie.

You'll want to know: chéngshí

chéngshí — "honest".

> *tā shì yí ge chéngshí de rén* — He's an honest person.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngshí is built from *chéng* and *shí*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *zyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'trustworthy' and the second 'full' and 'sincere'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngshí*
- *Say it: chéngshí*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì yí ge chéngshí de rén* — He's an honest person.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an uncle, then the Mandarin for an auntie, then say *chéngshí* again

Before you move on

What does chéngshí mean? ("Honest".) Say it once more.

273.2 好客 (hàokè) — hospitable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an auntie, then the Mandarin for honest.

You'll want to know: 好客

好客 — *hàokè* — "hospitable".

tāmen jiā fēicháng hàokè — Their family is very hospitable.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好客 (*hàokè*) is built from 好, here said with a falling tone, 'to be fond of', and 客 'a guest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawH* and *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a guest'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: hàokè*
- *Say it: hàokè*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen jiā fēicháng hàokè* — Their family is very hospitable.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an auntie, then the Mandarin for honest, then say *hàokè* again

Before you move on

What does 好客 mean? ("Hospitable".) Say it once more.

273.3 用心 (yòngxīn) — attentive; putting your heart into it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for honest, then the Mandarin for hospitable.

You'll want to know: 用心

用心 — *yòngxīn* — "attentive; putting your heart into it".

我老公工作很用心 *wǒ lǎogōng gōngzuò hěn yòngxīn* — My husband puts his heart into his work.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

用心 (*yòngxīn*) is built from 用 'to use' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yowngH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: yòngxīn*
- *Say it: yòngxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ lǎogōng gōngzuò hěn yòngxīn* — My husband puts his heart into his work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for honest, then the Mandarin for hospitable, then say *yòngxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 用心 mean? ("Attentive; putting your heart into it".) Say it once more.

273.4 cūxīn — careless

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hospitable, then the Mandarin for putting your heart into it.

You'll want to know: cūxīn

cūxīn — "careless".

nǐ tài cūxīn le — You're so careless.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cūxīn is built from *cū* 'coarse' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzuX* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'rough'. Middle Chinese *dzuX* would regularly give zù; the initial and the level tone of cū are irregular.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūxīn*
- *Say it: cūxīn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ tài cūxīn le* — You're so careless.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hospitable, then the Mandarin for putting your heart into it, then say *cūxīn* again

Before you move on

What does cūxīn mean? ("Careless".) Say it once more.

273.5 xìxīn — careful; attentive to detail

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for putting your heart into it, then the Mandarin for careless.

You'll want to know: xìxīn

xìxīn — "careful; attentive to detail".

tā gōngzuò hěn xìxīn — She's very careful in her work.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìxīn is built from *xì* 'fine' and 忄 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sejH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'small'.

What you've built

One more word for describing things.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìxīn*
- *Say it: xìxīn*, once more

- *Say it: tā gōngzuò hěn xìxīn* — She's very careful in her work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for putting your heart into it, then the Mandarin for careless, then say *xìxīn* again

Before you move on

What does xìxīn mean? ("Careful; attentive to detail".) Say it once more.

Chapter 274

Free Time

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about skating, collecting things, what is all the rage, handicrafts and sports fans.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 274: I can talk about skating, collecting things, what is all the rage, handicrafts and sports fans.*

274.1 huábīng — to ice-skate

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for careless, then the Mandarin for careful with details.

You'll want to know: huábīng

huábīng — "to ice-skate".

> *dōngtiān wǒmen qù huábīng* — In winter we go skating.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huábīng is built from *huá* 'slippery' and *bīng* 'ice', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweat* and *ping* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'smooth' and quotes an older dictionary for the second, 'frozen water'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: huábīng*
- *Say it: huábīng*, once more
- *Say it: dōngtiān wǒmen qù huábīng* — In winter we go skating.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for careless, then the Mandarin for careful with details, then say *huábīng* again

Before you move on

What does huábīng mean? ("To ice-skate".) Say it once more.

274.2 shōují — to collect things

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for careful with details, then the Mandarin for to ice-skate.

You'll want to know: shōují

shōují — "to collect things".

wǒ xǐhuan shōují yóupiào — I like collecting stamps.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōují is built from *shōu* 'to gather in' and *jí* 'to assemble', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw* and *dzip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to gather in' and the second 'to gather'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōují*
- *Say it: shōují*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan shōují yóupiào* — I like collecting stamps.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for careful with details, then the Mandarin for to ice-skate, then say *shōují* again

Before you move on

What does shōují mean? (“To collect things”.) Say it once more.

274.3 热门 (rèmén) — popular; all the rage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ice-skate, then the Mandarin for to collect things.

You’ll want to know: 热门

热门 — *rèmén* — “popular; all the rage”.

这本小说很热门 *zhè běn xiǎoshuō hěn rèmén* — This novel is all the rage.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

热门 (*rèmén*) is built from 热 ’hot’ and 门 ’a door’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyet* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription). How a hot door came to mean something popular is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: rèmén*
- *Say it: rèmén*, once more

- *Say it: zhè běn xiǎoshuō hěn rèmén* — This novel is all the rage.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ice-skate, then the Mandarin for to collect things, then say *rèmén* again

Before you move on

What does 热门 mean? ("Popular; all the rage".) Say it once more.

274.4 手工 (shǒugōng) — handicraft; things made by hand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to collect things, then the Mandarin for all the rage.

You'll want to know: 手工

手工 — *shǒugōng* — "handicraft; things made by hand".

我们先做手工 *wǒmen xiān zuò shǒugōng* — Let's do the crafts first.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

手工 (*shǒugōng*) is built from 手 'the hand' and 工 'work', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒugōng*
- *Say it: shǒugōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiān zuò shǒugōng* — Let's do the crafts first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to collect things, then the Mandarin for all the rage, then say *shǒugōng* again

Before you move on

What does 手工 mean? (“Handicraft; things made by hand”.) Say it once more.

274.5 qiúmí — sports fan

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all the rage, then the Mandarin for handicrafts.

You’ll want to know: qiúmí

qiúmí — “sports fan”.

wǒ bàba shì yí ge qiúmí — My dad is a big sports fan.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiúmí is built from *qiú* ’a ball’ and *mí*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *mej* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the second ’to be led astray’.

What you’ve built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúmí*
- *Say it: qiúmí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba shì yí ge qiúmí* — My dad is a big sports fan.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all the rage, then the Mandarin for handicrafts, then say *qiúmí* again

Before you move on

What does qiúmí mean? (“Sports fan”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 275

Saying Sorry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise, forgive, say yes to a request, accept an apology, and say it is up to you.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 275: I can apologise, forgive, say yes to a request, accept an apology, and say it is up to you.*

275.1 dàoqiàn — to apologise

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for handicrafts, then the Mandarin for a sports fan.

You'll want to know: dàoqiàn

dàoqiàn — "to apologise".

> *tā dàoqiàn le* — He apologised.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàoqiàn is built from *dào* and *qiàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dawX* and *kheamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a road' and 'a principle'. It gives the second other senses; how the pair came to mean an apology is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàoqiàn*
- *Say it: dàoqiàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā dàoqiàn le* — He apologised.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for handicrafts, then the Mandarin for a sports fan, then say *dàoqiàn* again

Before you move on

What does dàoqiàn mean? ("To apologise".) Say it once more.

275.2 yuánliàng — to forgive

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sports fan, then the Mandarin for to apologise.

You'll want to know: yuánliàng

yuánliàng — "to forgive".

qǐng yuánliàng wǒ — Please forgive me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuánliàng is built from *yuán* and *liàng* 'to trust', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwon* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a broad plain' and the second 'to trust'. How the pair came to mean forgiving is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuánliàng*
- *Say it: yuánliàng*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng yuánliàng wǒ* — Please forgive me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sports fan, then the Mandarin for to apologise, then say *yuánliàng* again

Before you move on

What does yuánliàng mean? ("To forgive".) Say it once more.

275.3 dāying — to agree (to a request); to say yes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to apologise, then the Mandarin for to forgive.

You'll want to know: dāying

dāying — "to agree (to a request); to say yes".

tā dāying le — He said yes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dāying is built from *dā* 'to answer' and *yìng* 'to respond', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *top* and *'ingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to match' and the second 'things answering each other'. In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāying*
- *Say it: dāying*, once more
- *Say it: tā dāying le* — He said yes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to apologise, then the Mandarin for to forgive, then say *dāying* again

Before you move on

What does dāying mean? ("To agree (to a request); to say yes".) Say it once more.

275.4 jiēshòu — to accept

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to forgive, then the Mandarin for to say yes to a request.

You'll want to know: jiēshòu

jiēshòu — "to accept".

wǒ jiēshòu nǐ de dàoqiàn — I accept your apology.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiēshòu is built from *jiē* and *shòu*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjep* and *dzyuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to join' and 'to hold', and the second 'to take in'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiēshòu*
- *Say it: jiēshòu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiēshòu nǐ de dàoqiàn* — I accept your apology.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to forgive, then the Mandarin for to say yes to a request, then say *jiēshòu* again

Before you move on

What does jiēshòu mean? ("To accept".) Say it once more.

275.5 suíbiàn — as you like; casual

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to say yes to a request, then the Mandarin for to accept.

You'll want to know: suíbiàn

suíbiàn — "as you like; casual".

nǐ suíbiàn chī — Help yourself to anything.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suíbiàn is built from *suí* 'to follow' and *biàn* 'convenient', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zjwe* and *bjienH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to follow' and the second 'to benefit'.

What you've built

One more word for saying no and asking.

Your turn

- *Say it: suíbiàn*
- *Say it: suíbiàn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ suíbiàn chī* — Help yourself to anything.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to say yes to a request, then the Mandarin for to accept, then say *suíbiàn* again

Before you move on

What does suíbiàn mean? ("As you like; casual".) Say it once more.

Chapter 276

A New Job

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I went for an interview or quit a job, talk about a chance and retiring, and say something is a big deal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 276: I can say I went for an interview or quit a job, talk about a chance and retiring, and say something is a big deal.*

276.1 面试 (miànshì) — to have an interview (for a job); interview

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to accept, then the Mandarin for as you like.

You'll want to know: 面试

面试 — *miànshì* — "to have an interview (for a job); interview".

> 上个月我老公去面试了 *shàng ge yuè wǒ lǎogōng qù miànshì le* — My husband went for a job interview last month.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

面试 (*miànshì*) is built from 面 'the face' and 试 'a test', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjienH* and *syiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to face' and the second 'to use'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: miànshì*
- *Say it: miànshì*, once more
- *Say it: shàng ge yuè wǒ lǎogōng qù miànshì le* — My husband went for a job interview last month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to accept, then the Mandarin for as you like, then say *miànshì* again

Before you move on

What does 面试 mean? ("To have an interview (for a job); interview".) Say it once more.

276.2 cízhí — to resign; to quit a job

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as you like, then the Mandarin for to have a job interview.

You'll want to know: cízhí

cízhí — "to resign; to quit a job".

tā shàng ge yuè cízhí le — She quit her job last month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cízhí is built from *cí* and *zhí* 'a post', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zi* and *tsyik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'words' and 'a plea'. The sense 'to take leave' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: cízhí*
- *Say it: cízhí*, once more
- *Say it: tā shàng ge yuè cízhí le* — She quit her job last month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as you like, then the Mandarin for to have a job interview, then say *cízhí* again

Before you move on

What does cízhí mean? ("To resign; to quit a job".) Say it once more.

276.3 机会 (jīhuì) — chance; opportunity

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a job interview, then the Mandarin for to quit a job.

You'll want to know: 机会

机会 — *jīhuì* — "chance; opportunity".

这是一个好机会 *zhè shì yí ge hǎo jīhuì* — This is a good opportunity.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

机会 (*jīhuì*) is built from 机 and 会 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kj+j* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a meeting' and 'a trigger', and the second 'to come together'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīhuì*
- *Say it: jīhuì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì yí ge hǎo jīhuì* — This is a good opportunity.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a job interview, then the Mandarin for to quit a job, then say *jīhuì* again

Before you move on

What does 机会 mean? ("Chance; opportunity".) Say it once more.

276.4 tuìxiū — to retire

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to quit a job, then the Mandarin for an opportunity.

You'll want to know: tuìxiū

tuìxiū — "to retire".

wǒ yéye tuìxiū le — My grandpa has retired.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuìxiū is built from *tuì* 'to step back' and *xiū* 'to rest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwojH* and *xjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to step back' and the second 'to rest'.

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuìxiū*
- *Say it: tuìxiū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yéye tuìxiū le* — My grandpa has retired.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to quit a job, then the Mandarin for an opportunity, then say *tuìxiū* again

Before you move on

What does tuìxiū mean? ("To retire".) Say it once more.

276.5 大事 (dàshì) — big deal; important matter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an opportunity, then the Mandarin for to retire.

You'll want to know: 大事

大事 — *dàshì* — "big deal; important matter".

找工作是大事 *zhǎo gōngzuò shì dàshì* — Finding a job is a big deal.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大事 (*dàshì*) is built from 大 'big' and 事 'an affair', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for talking about the past.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàshì*
- *Say it: dàshì*, once more

- *Say it: zhǎo gōngzuò shì dàshì* — Finding a job is a big deal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an opportunity, then the Mandarin for to retire, then say *dàshì* again

Before you move on

What does 大事 mean? ("Big deal; important matter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 277

Likes and Dislikes

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what is amusing, what I dislike, whom I admire, what I enjoy and what I love.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 277: I can say what is amusing, what I dislike, whom I admire, what I enjoy and what I love.*

277.1 yǒuqù — fun; amusing

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to retire, then the Mandarin for a big deal.

You'll want to know: yǒuqù

yǒuqù — "fun; amusing".

> *zhège gùshi hěn yǒuqù* — This story is a lot of fun.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒuqù is built from 有 'to have' and *qù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *tshjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to tend towards'. How the pair came to mean amusing is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒuqù*
- *Say it: yǒuqù*, once more
- *Say it: zhège gùshi hěn yǒuqù* — This story is a lot of fun.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to retire, then the Mandarin for a big deal, then say *yǒuqù* again

Before you move on

What does yǒuqù mean? ("Fun; amusing".) Say it once more.

277.2 tǎoyàn — to dislike; to hate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a big deal, then the Mandarin for amusing.

You'll want to know: tǎoyàn

tǎoyàn — "to dislike; to hate".

wǒ tǎoyàn xiàyǔ tiān — I hate rainy days.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǎoyàn is built from *tǎo* and *yàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thawX* and *'jiemH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to govern' and 'to punish', and for the second quotes the Analects, on not tiring of fine food. How the pair came to mean disliking is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǎoyàn*
- *Say it: tǎoyàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ tǎoyàn xiàyǔ tiān* — I hate rainy days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a big deal, then the Mandarin for amusing, then say *tǎoyàn* again

Before you move on

What does tǎoyàn mean? ("To dislike; to hate".) Say it once more.

277.3 xīnshǎng — to admire; to appreciate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for amusing, then the Mandarin for to dislike.

You'll want to know: xīnshǎng

xīnshǎng — "to admire; to appreciate".

wǒ hěn xīnshǎng tā — I really admire him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnshǎng is built from *xīn* 'glad' and *shǎng* 'to reward', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xj+n* and *syangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'glad' and the second 'to bestow'.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnshǎng*
- *Say it: xīnshǎng*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ hěn xīnshǎng tā* — I really admire him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for amusing, then the Mandarin for to dislike, then say *xīnshǎng* again

Before you move on

What does xīnshǎng mean? ("To admire; to appreciate".) Say it once more.

277.4 xiǎngshòu — to enjoy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dislike, then the Mandarin for to admire.

You'll want to know: xiǎngshòu

xiǎngshòu — "to enjoy".

wǒmen zài xiǎngshòu jiàqī — We're enjoying the holidays.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiǎngshòu is built from *xiǎng* and *shòu*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjangX* and *dzyuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the first under an older spelling and glosses it 'to offer' and 'to sacrifice', and glosses the second 'to take in'. How the first came to mean enjoying is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎngshòu*
- *Say it: xiǎngshòu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài xiǎngshòu jiàqī* — We're enjoying the holidays.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dislike, then the Mandarin for to admire, then say *xiǎngshòu* again

Before you move on

What does xiǎngshòu mean? (“To enjoy”.) Say it once more.

277.5 rè’ài — to love deeply

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to admire, then the Mandarin for to enjoy.

You’ll want to know: rè’ài

rè’ài — “to love deeply”.

tā rè’ài yīnyuè — He loves music.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rè’ài is built from 热 ’hot’ and *ài* ’to love’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyet* and *’ojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the second ’to cherish’.

What you’ve built

One more word for what I like.

Your turn

- *Say it: rè’ài*
- *Say it: rè’ài*, once more
- *Say it: tā rè’ài yīnyuè* — He loves music.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to admire, then the Mandarin for to enjoy, then say *rè’ài* again

Before you move on

What does rè'ài mean? ("To love deeply".) Say it once more.

277.6 Looking back: from Husband and Wife to Likes and Dislikes

Say the Mandarin for a wife and hubby.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a wife, hubby, grandpa on the mother's side, an uncle, an auntie
- *Say it:* honest, hospitable, putting your heart into it, careless, careful with details
- *Say it:* to ice-skate, to collect things, all the rage, handicrafts, a sports fan
- *Say it:* to apologise, to forgive, to say yes to a request, to accept, as you like
- *Say it:* to have a job interview, to quit a job, an opportunity, to retire, a big deal
- *Say it:* amusing, to dislike, to admire, to enjoy, to love deeply
- *Read it:* 老 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A wife? (*qīzi.*) Hubby? (老公, *lǎogōng.*) Grandpa on the mother's side? (外公, *wàigōng.*) An uncle? (*shūshu.*) An auntie? (*āyí.*) Honest? (*chéngshí.*) Hospitable? (好客, *hàokè.*) Putting your heart into it? (用心, *yòngxīn.*) Careless? (*cūxīn.*) Careful with details? (*xìxīn.*) To ice-skate? (*huábīng.*) To collect things? (*shōují.*) All the rage? (热门, *rèmén.*) Handicrafts? (手工, *shǒugōng.*) A sports fan? (*qiúmí.*) To apologise? (*dàoqiàn.*) To forgive? (*yuánliàng.*) To say yes to a request? (*dāying.*) To accept? (*jiēshòu.*) As you like? (*suíbiàn.*) To have a job interview? (面试, *miànshì.*) To quit a job?

(*cízhí.*) An opportunity? (机会, *jīhuì.*) To retire? (*tuìxiū.*) A big deal? (大事, *dàshì.*) Amusing? (*yǒuqù.*) To dislike? (*tǎoyàn.*) To admire? (*xīnshǎng.*) To enjoy? (*xiǎngshòu.*) To love deeply? (*rè'ài.*)

277.7 Likes and Dislikes — once more

Say the Mandarin for amusing and to dislike.

Your turn

- *Say it:* amusing, to dislike, to admire, to enjoy, to love deeply

Before you move on

Amusing? (*yǒuqù.*) To dislike? (*tǎoyàn.*) To admire? (*xīnshǎng.*) To enjoy? (*xiǎngshòu.*) To love deeply? (*rè'ài.*)

Chapter 278

First, Then, Last

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell what happened first, next and last.
>
> *Telling things in order with* 先, 然后 *and* 最后, *first of all and straight after, and* 了 … 以后 *for after doing, built on two new written characters:* 最 *and* 然.

278.1 最后 (zuìhòu) — last; finally

A new chapter, and it opens on the word for the end of a story.

- *Recall:* say *rè'ài*, to love deeply — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *xiǎngshòu*, to enjoy — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *zuì*, most — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *hòu*, after; behind — **R3**

You'll want to know: 最后

最后 — *zuìhòu* — "last; finally; in the end".

> 最后我们回家了 *zuìhòu wǒmen huí jiā le* — In the end we went home.
>
> 今天是最后一天 *jīntiān shì zuìhòu yì tiān* — Today is the last day.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. It is the *zuì* you already say for most.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

最后 (*zuìhòu*) is built from 最 'most' and 后 'after', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tswajH* and *huwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'utmost' and lists the second, under its traditional form, with 'before and after'; 'last' for the pair is the word's own sense.

What you've built

最后 opens the last step of a story: 最后我们回家了 *zuìhòu wǒmen huí jiā le.* Before a noun it picks out the last one: 最后一天 *zuìhòu yì tiān.* The 了 at the end is the 了 you know: it happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuìhòu*
- *Say it: zuìhòu*, once more
- *Say it:* 最后我们回家了 — *zuìhòu wǒmen huí jiā le* — In the end we went home.
- *Say it:* 今天是最后一天 — *jīntiān shì zuìhòu yì tiān* — Today is the last day.
- *Recall:* say *zuì*, then *zuìhòu*

Before you move on

What does 最后 mean? ("Last; finally".) Which word you know is inside it? (*zuì*, most.)

278.2 最 — 日, six strokes, then 又

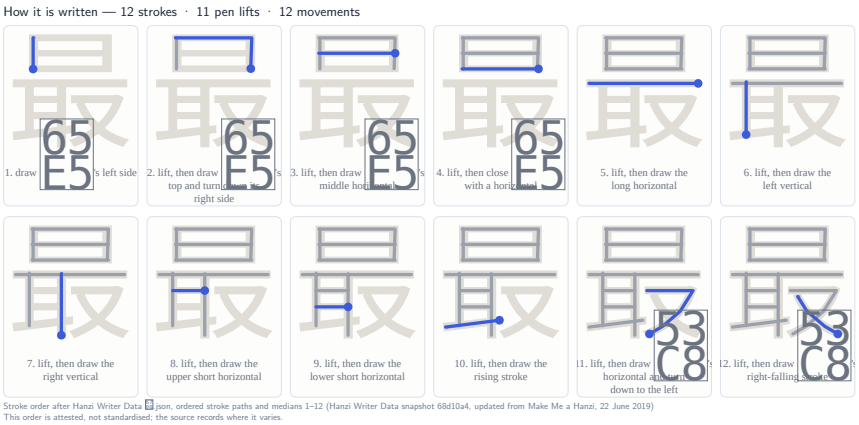
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zuìhòu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

日 对

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *duì*

Script — 日, six strokes, then 又



How 最 *is written, stroke by stroke*

最

Three pieces, and you write two of them already.

日**, four strokes**, wide and flat on top: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, the bottom bar.

Six strokes under it: a long horizontal across the whole width; then, on the left, two verticals down from it, the left one first; two short horizontals between them, the upper one first; and last a short stroke at the foot that rises to the right.

又**, two strokes**, on the right, as on the left of 对: a horizontal that turns and falls to the lower left, then a long right-falling stroke.

4 + 6 + 2 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 最, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 最? (**Twelve.**) What sits on top? (日.) Which stroke rises to the right? (**The last of the six, at the foot, before** 又.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 最, pinned stroke paths and medians.

278.3 先...然后...最后 — first, then, last

Three words you have, and one story to put them in.

- *Read it:* 最后, aloud — *zuìhòu*
- *Recall:* say 先 — *xiān*, first — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *ránhòu*, then; after that — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 先, 然后, 最后 — first, then, last

To tell things in order, put 先 before the first verb, 然后 at the front of the next step, and 最后 at the front of the last.

我先吃饭 然后看书 最后回家 *wǒ xiān chī fàn, ránhòu kàn shū, zuìhòu huí jiā* — First I eat, then I read, and last I go home.

然后 is the *ránhòu* you have said since the chapter on the past. Now it prints: the next lesson puts 然 in your hand.
先 sits after the person, right before the verb: 我先吃饭. 然后 and 最后 open their clause, and the person need not be said again.

他先去学校 然后去打工 *tā xiān qù xuéxiào, ránhòu qù dǎgōng* — He goes to school first, then to his part-time job.

The order of the clauses is the order of the events.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我先吃饭 然后看书 最后回家 — *wǒ xiān chī fàn, ránhòu kàn shū, zuìhòu huí jiā* — First I eat, then I read, and last I go home.
- 他先去学校 然后去打工 — *tā xiān qù xuéxiào, ránhòu qù dǎgōng* — He goes to school first, then to his part-time job.
- three things you did this morning, in order, with 先, 然后 and 最后

Before you move on

Where does 先 go? (**After the person, before the first verb.**) And 然后 and 最后? (**At the front of their clause.**)

278.4 然 — a four-stroke piece, 大 with a dot, and four dots

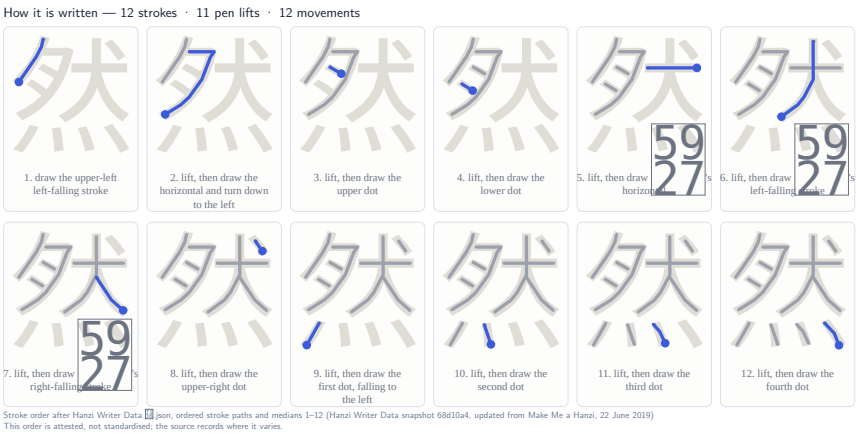
The pattern first, then the character it was waiting for.

- *Recall:* say 我先吃饭 然后看书 — *wǒ xiān chī fàn, ránhòu kàn shū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  大 点 热

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dà*, *diǎn*, *rè*

Script — a four-stroke piece, 大 with a dot, and four dots



How 然 is written, stroke by stroke

然

Three pieces, and you write the last two already.

The upper left, four strokes: a left-falling stroke; a horizontal that turns and falls to the lower left; then two dots inside it, the upper one first. It is not 月: there is no hooked frame and no inner bar.

大 with a dot, four strokes, on the upper right: the bar, the left-falling stroke from above it, the right-falling stroke, and last a dot at its upper right.

Four dots along the foot, from left to right, as at the foot of 点 and 热.

4 + 4 + 4 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 然, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 然? (**Twelve**.) Which character you write sits on the upper right? (**大, with a dot added**.) Where else have you written the four dots? (**At the foot of 点 and 热**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 然, pinned stroke paths and medians.

278.5 shǒuxiān — first of all

Before the new one: the character you wrote last, inside the word it belongs to.

- *Read it:* 然后, aloud — *ránhòu*
- *Recall:* say 我先吃饭 — *wǒ xiān chī fàn* — **R1**, two lessons back

You'll want to know: shǒuxiān

shǒuxiān — "first of all; to begin with".

> *shǒuxiān wǒ xiǎng shuō xièxie* — First of all, I'd like to say thank you.
>
> *shǒuxiān wǒmen qù mǎi dōngxi* — To begin with, we go shopping.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǒuxiān is built from shǒu 'the head' and 先 'first', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *sen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'the head' and 'the beginning', and the second 'before and after'.

What you've built

先 sits inside the clause, after the person: 我先吃饭. *shǒuxiān* opens the sentence, before the person, and it sounds planned: the first of several points.
然后 and 最后 follow it as usual: *shǒuxiān …, ránhòu …, zuìhòu ….*

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒuxiān*
- *Say it: shǒuxiān*, once more
- *Say it: shǒuxiān wǒ xiǎng shuō xièxie* — First of all, I'd like to say thank you.
- *Say it: shǒuxiān wǒmen qù mǎi dōngxi* — To begin with, we go shopping.
- *Recall:* say 先, then *shǒuxiān*: inside the clause, then at its front

Before you move on

What does *shǒuxiān* mean? (“First of all”.) Where does it stand? (**At the very front, before the person**.)

278.6 jiēzhe — next; straight after that

Before the new one: last lesson’s word, and the pattern it opens.

- *Recall:* say *shǒuxiān*, first of all — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Read it:* 先 … 然后 … 最后, aloud — *xiān … ránhòu … zuìhòu*

You’ll want to know: jiēzhe

jiēzhe — “next; straight after that”.

> *wǒ xiān xǐ yīfu, jiēzhe zuòfàn* — First I wash the clothes, and straight after that I cook.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiēzhe is built from jiē ’to join on’ and a light ending, zhe. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsjep* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), glossed ’to join’ and ’to hold’. The second is written with a character the dictionary lists under five readings, *drjo*, *trjoX*, *trjoH*, *trjak* and *drjak*, and it glosses none of them as this ending, so the history of that part is not settled.

What you’ve built

ránhòu leaves a little room between the steps; *jiēzhe* says the next one follows on at once.
Like 然后, it opens its clause: *wǒ xiān xǐ yīfu, jiēzhe zuòfàn.*

Your turn

- *Say it: jiēzhe*

- *Say it: jiēzhe*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiān xǐ yīfu, jiēzhe zuòfàn* — First I wash the clothes, and straight after that I cook.
- *Say it: wǒ xiān chī zǎofàn, jiēzhe qù xuéxiào* — I have breakfast first, then go straight to school.
- *Recall:* say *ránhòu*, then *jiēzhe*: then, and straight after

Before you move on

What does *jiēzhe* mean? ("Next; straight after that".) Where does it go? (**At the front of its clause, as 然后 does**.)

278.7 吃了饭以后 — after doing something

Two things you have, put together in a new way.

- *Recall:* say *jiēzhe*, straight after — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *shǒuxiān*, first of all — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 以后 — *yǐhòu*, after; later — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 我看了书 — *wǒ kàn le shū* — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 了 ... 以后, after doing something

To say one thing comes after another is done, put 了 after the first verb and 以后 at the end of its clause; the next thing follows.

吃了饭以后 我们去买东西 *chī le fàn yǐhòu, wǒmen qù mǎi dōngxi* — After we've eaten, we'll go shopping. 下了课以后 他去打工 *xià le kè yǐhòu, tā qù dǎgōng* — After class he goes to his part-time job.

了 here is the 了 of a finished action, the one in 我看了书: the first event is complete before the second starts. It works for what happened and for what is planned; the rest of the sentence tells you which. 下课 opens up to take 了 in the middle: 下了课.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 吃了饭以后 我们去买东西 — *chī le fàn yǐhòu, wǒmen qù mǎi dōngxi* — After we've eaten, we'll go shopping.
- 下了课以后 他去打工 — *xià le kè yǐhòu, tā qù dǎgōng* — After class he goes to his part-time job.
- 回了家以后 我想看书 — *huí le jiā yǐhòu, wǒ xiǎng kàn shū* — Once I'm home, I want to read.
- what you do after you have eaten tonight

Before you move on

Where does 了 go? (**After the first verb**.) And 以后? (**At the end of the first clause**.) Is the first thing done before the second starts? (**Yes: that is what 了 says**.)

278.8 先洗手 然后吃早饭

The chapter closes here, with one person's day told in order.

- *Read it:* 吃了饭以后, aloud — *chī le fàn yǐhòu*
- *Recall:* say *jiēzhe*, straight after — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *shǒuxiān*, first of all — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你早上做什么

nǐ zǎoshang zuò shénme — What do you do in the morning?

B: 我先洗手 然后吃早饭

wǒ xiān xǐ shǒu, ránhòu chī zǎofàn — I wash my hands first, then have breakfast.

A: 吃了早饭以后呢

chī le zǎofàn yǐhòu ne — And after breakfast?

B: *jiēzhe qù xuéxiào* — Straight off to school.

A: 下了课以后呢

xià le kè yǐhòu ne — And after class?

B: 先去打工 最后回家

xiān qù dǎgōng, zuìhòu huí jiā — First my part-time job, and last home.

The order of the clauses is the order of the day. B never says 我 after the first line: the person is clear, so Mandarin leaves it out.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — telling it in order

Five ways to keep a story in order, all at the front of a clause or right before the verb:

- 先 *xiān* — first, before the verb.
- *shǒuxiān* — first of all, at the very front.
- 然后 *ránhòu* and *jiēzhe* — then, and straight after.
- 最后 *zuìhòu* — last.
- 吃了饭以后 *chī le fàn yǐhòu* — after doing something.

Listen. *Nǐ zuótiān xiān zuò le shénme?*
Speak. Tell your morning in four steps: 先, 然后, *jiēzhe*, 最后.
Write it: 最后 — 日 first, then the six strokes, then the piece from the left of 对

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我先洗手 然后吃早饭 最后去学校 — *wǒ xiān xǐ shǒu, ránhòu chī zǎofàn, zuìhòu qù xuéxiào* — I wash my hands, then have breakfast, and last go to school.

- *Say it:* 吃了早饭以后 我去学校 — *chī le zǎofàn yǐhòu, wǒ qù xuéxiào* — After breakfast I go to school.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 先吃饭 然后看书

Before you move on

Say you wash your hands first, then eat. (我先洗手 然后吃饭.) Say after class. (下了课以后.) Which word opens the last step? (最后.)

Chapter 279

The Next Day

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what was going on when something happened, and follow a short story.
>
> *Saying what was going on when something happened with …的时候 and 正在, suddenly, all at once and the next day, and reading a story of thirteen lines, built on two new written characters:* 第 *and* 突.

279.1 第二天 (dì'èr tiān) — the next day

A new chapter, and it opens on the morning after.

- *Recall:* say 先洗手 然后吃早饭 — *xiān xǐ shǒu, ránhòu chī zǎofàn* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *jiēzhe*, straight after — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *dìyī*, first — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 明天 — *míngtiān*, tomorrow — **R3**

You'll want to know: 第二天

第二天 — *dì'èr tiān* — "the next day; the following day".

> 第二天我们去了山上 *dì'èr tiān wǒmen qù le shān shàng* — The next day we went up the mountain.

In a story, 第二天 is the day after the one you are telling; 明天 counts from today.

山上 is 山 with 上, the short form of *shàngbian*: up on the mountain.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. It is the dì of *dìyī*, first.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

第二天 (*dì'èr tiān*) is built from 第, which puts a number in order, 二 'two' and 天 'day'. All three are inherited from Middle Chinese, *dejH*, *nyijH* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'order, sequence'. 'The next day' for the whole is the phrase's own sense: the second day of a story.

What you've built

第 before a number makes it an ordinal: *dìyī*, first, is one you say already, and 第二 is second.
第二天 counts from the day the story is on, so it can follow a day in the past: 第二天天气很好 *dì'èr tiān tiānqì hěn hǎo*.

Your turn

- *Say it: dì'èr tiān*
- *Say it: dì'èr tiān*, once more
- *Say it:* 第二天我们去了山上 — *dì'èr tiān wǒmen qù le shān shàng* — The next day we went up the mountain.
- *Say it:* 第二天天气很好 — *dì'èr tiān tiānqì hěn hǎo* — The next day the weather was fine.
- *Recall:* say *dìyī*, then 第二天

Before you move on

What does 第二天 mean? ("The next day".) How is it different from 明天? (**明天 counts from today; 第二天 from the day in the story**.)

279.2 第 — the bamboo piece of 笑, then a five-stroke body

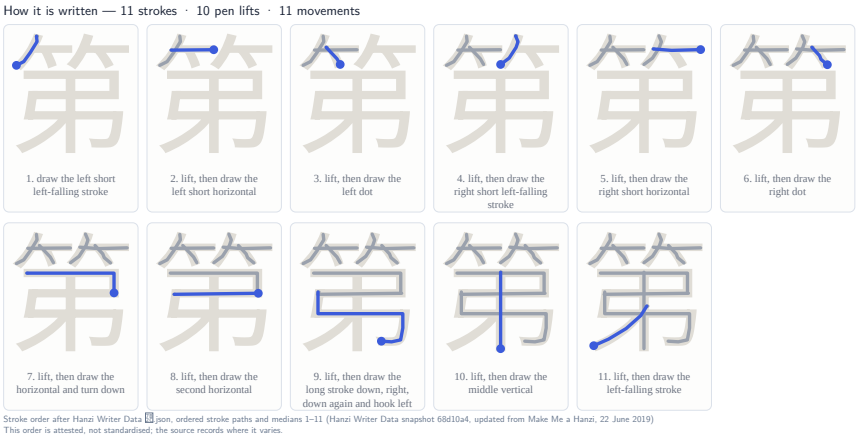
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dì'èr tiān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  笑 号

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xiào*, *hào*

Script — the bamboo piece of 笑, then a five-stroke body



How 第 *is written, stroke by stroke*

第

Two pieces, and you write the first already.

The bamboo piece, six strokes, as on top of 笑: on the left a left-falling stroke, a short horizontal from it and a dot; then the same three on the right.

The body, five strokes: a horizontal that turns down at its right end; a horizontal under it; a stroke that goes down, right, down again and hooks to the left, folding the way the foot of 号 does; the vertical down the middle; and last a left-falling stroke to the lower left.

6 + 5 = eleven. The left-falling stroke comes after the vertical, last of all.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 第, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 第? (**Eleven**.) Where have you written its top? (**On 笑**.) Which stroke comes last? (**The left-falling stroke, after the vertical**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 第, pinned stroke paths and medians.

279.3 ...的时候 — when, and what was going on

A word for when, and a word for in the middle of.

- *Read it:* 第二天, aloud — *dì'èr tiān*
- *Recall:* say 时候 — *shíhou*, time; when — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 我正在吃饭 — *wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn* — **R3**

Grammar Lens: ...的时候 and 正在, for what was going on

...的时候 after a clause says when; 正在 in the other clause says what was already going on at that moment.

他来的时候 我正在吃饭 *tā lái de shíhou, wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn* — When he came, I was eating. 我回家的时候 妈妈正在做饭 *wǒ huí jiā de shíhou, māma zhèngzài zuòfàn* — When I got home, Mum was cooking.

The clause before 的时候 names the moment, and a bare verb is enough: 他来的时候. The other clause is the scene that was already running, with the 正在 of 我正在吃饭.
正在 has no tense of its own: the story around it puts the scene in the past.
All three characters of 的时候 are ones you write, so it prints whole for the first time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 他来的时候 我正在吃饭 — *tā lái de shíhou, wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn* — When he came, I was eating.
- 我回家的时候 妈妈正在做饭 — *wǒ huí jiā de shíhou, māma zhèngzài zuòfàn* — When I got home, Mum was cooking.
- 我看书的时候 他来了 — *wǒ kàn shū de shíhou, tā lái le* — He came while I was reading.
- what you were doing when somebody phoned you last

Before you move on

What does …的时候 give you? (**The moment: when**.) Which word gives the scene that was already going on? (正在.)

279.4 突然 (tūrán) — suddenly

Before the new one: a moment, and then something breaking into it.

- *Read it:* 他来的时候 我正在吃饭, aloud — *tā lái de shíhou, wǒ zhèngzài chī fàn*
- *Read it:* 然后, aloud — *ránhòu*
- *Recall:* say 下雨 — *xiàyǔ*, to rain — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 突然

突然 — *tūrán* — "suddenly; all of a sudden".

突然下雨了 *tūrán xiàyǔ le* — Suddenly it started to rain.

他突然来了 *tā tūrán lái le* — He turned up out of the blue.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. The second is the 然 of 然后.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

突然 (*tūrán*) is built from 突 and 然, both inherited from Middle Chinese. The Guangyun lists 突 under two readings: *thwot*, glossed 'the look of coming out', and *dwot*, glossed 'to butt' and 'to deceive'; tū is the regular modern sound of *thwot*. 然 is *nyen*, glossed as a particle and 'so, like this' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'Suddenly' for the pair is the word's own sense, which neither gloss gives.

What you've built

突然 goes before the verb, or at the front of the clause: 突然下雨了, 他突然来了.
With …的时候 it breaks into a scene: 我看书的时候 他突然来了 *wǒ kàn shū de shíhou, tā tūrán lái le.*

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tūrán*
- *Say it:* *tūrán*, once more
- *Say it:* 突然下雨了 — *tūrán xiàyǔ le* — Suddenly it started to rain.
- *Say it:* 我看书的时候 他突然来了 — *wǒ kàn shū de shíhou, tā tūrán lái le* — I was reading when he suddenly came.
- *Recall:* say 然后, then 突然: the same 然, two words

Before you move on

What does 突然 mean? ("Suddenly".) Where does it go? (**Before the verb, or at the front of its clause**.)

279.5 突 — the roof of 家, 八, then 大 with a dot

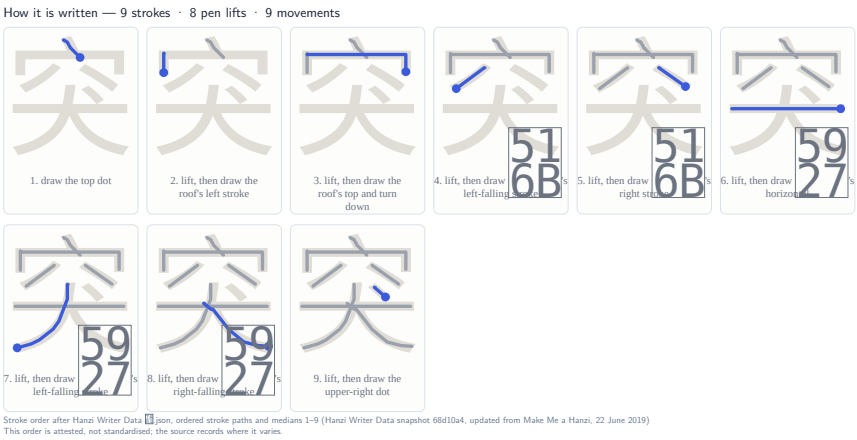
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tūrán* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

家 八 然

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jiā*, *bā*, *rán*

Script — the roof of 家, 八, then 大 with a dot



How 突 is written, stroke by stroke

突

Three pieces, and you write every one of them already.

The roof, three strokes, as on top of 家: the dot, a short left stroke, then a horizontal that hooks down at its right end.

八, two strokes, under the roof: a left-falling stroke, then a dot falling to the right.

大 with a dot, four strokes, at the foot, as on the right of 然: the bar, the left-falling stroke, the right-falling stroke, and the dot at its upper right last.

3 + 2 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 突, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 突? (**Nine.**) Which character you write has the same roof? (家.) Where have you met the piece at the foot?

(**On the right of 然.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 突, pinned stroke paths and medians.

279.6 一下子 (yíxiàzi) — all at once

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then 一 with its rising tone.

- *Read it:* 突然, aloud — *tūrán*
- *Recall:* say 一个 — *yí ge*, with 一 rising — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 冷 — *lěng*, cold — **R3**

You'll want to know: 一下子

一下子 — *yíxiàzi* — "all at once; in no time".

天气一下子冷了 *tiānqì yíxiàzi lěng le* — All at once the weather turned cold.

一 rises before the fall of xià: *yíxiàzi*, as in *yí ge*.
Every character in it is one you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一下子 (*yíxiàzi*) is built from 一 'one', 下, here a single go, and the ending 子. All three are inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit*, *haeX* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists 下 under two readings, *haeX* and *haeH*, and glosses the first 'below' and 'to go down'; neither 'a go' nor 'all at once' is given there, so both are the modern word's own senses.

What you've built

突然 says it came without warning; 一下子 says the change took no time at all.
Both go before the verb: 天气一下子冷了 *tiānqì yíxiàzi lěng le*. The 了 at the end is the 了 of a change.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíxiàzi*
- *Say it: yíxiàzi*, once more
- *Say it:* 天气一下子冷了 — *tiānqì yíxiàzi lěng le* — All at once the weather turned cold.
- *Say it:* 我一下子明白了 — *wǒ yíxiàzi míngbai le* — All at once I understood.
- *Recall:* say 突然, then 一下子

Before you move on

What does 一下子 mean? ("All at once".) How does 一 sound in it? (**Rising: *yí***.)

279.7 (reading) — a day on the mountain

Thirteen short lines: a day that went wrong, then right.

- *Recall:* say 一下子 — *yíxiàzi*, all at once — **R1**, one lesson back

山上 山下

Read it: both aloud — *shān shàng*, *shān xià*

Read this

上个星期六 我和两个同学去山上 我们先开车 然后下车看花
中午我们在山上吃饭 吃了饭以后 突然下雨了 雨很大 我们
都没有雨衣 我们正在找车的时候 一个老人来了 他说 去我
家 他家在山下 我们在他家喝了茶 第二天 天气很好 我们先
去看了山上的花 然后回家了 最后 我们给他打了电话 说谢
谢 那天是我最开心的一天

Read it: the story through once without stopping; do not translate as you go

Read this

- *shàng ge xīngqīliù, wǒ hé liǎng ge tóngxué qù shān shàng* — Last Saturday two classmates and I went up the mountain.
- *wǒmen xiān kāichē, ránhòu xiàchē kàn huā* — First we drove, then we got out to look at the flowers.
- *zhōngwǔ wǒmen zài shān shàng chī fàn* — At noon we ate on the mountain.
- *chī le fàn yǐhòu, tūrán xiàyǔ le* — After we had eaten, it suddenly started to rain.
- *yǔ hěn dà, wǒmen dōu méiyǒu yǔyī* — The rain was heavy, and none of us had a raincoat.
- *wǒmen zhèngzài zhǎo chē de shíhou, yí ge lǎorén lái le* — While we were looking for the car, an old man came along.
- *tā shuō, qù wǒ jiā* — He said: come to my house.
- *tā jiā zài shān xià* — His house was at the foot of the mountain.
- *wǒmen zài tā jiā hē le chá* — We had tea at his house.
- *dì'èr tiān, tiānqì hěn hǎo* — The next day the weather was fine.
- *wǒmen xiān qù kàn le shān shàng de huā, ránhòu huí jiā le* — First we went to see the flowers on the mountain, then we went home.
- *zuìhòu, wǒmen gěi tā dǎ le diànhuà, shuō xièxie* — Last of all, we phoned him to say thank you.
- *nà tiān shì wǒ zuì kāixīn de yì tiān* — That was my happiest day.

Read this

Read it: the story a second time, the pinyin covered

Your turn

- Put these in order: the tea, the rain, the drive, the phone call. (**The drive, the rain, the tea, the phone call**.)

- The next day? (先去看了山上的花 然后回家了.)
- How did they thank him? (给他打了电话.)

Before you move on

Who came while they looked for the car? (一个老人.)

279.8 他突然来了

The chapter closes here: the story you read, told aloud as your own.

- *Read it:* 第二天 天气很好, aloud — *dì'èr tiān, tiānqì hěn hǎo*
- *Recall:* say 一下子 — *yíxiàzi* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 我回家的时候 妈妈正在做饭 — *wǒ huí jiā de shíhou, māma zhèngzài zuòfàn* — **R2**

The exchange

A: 上个星期六你做什么了

shàng ge xīngqīliù nǐ zuò shénme le — What did you do last Saturday?

B: 我和两个同学去山上了

wǒ hé liǎng ge tóngxué qù shān shàng le — Two classmates and I went up the mountain.

A: 天气好吗

tiānqì hǎo ma — Was the weather good?

B: 吃了饭以后 突然下雨了

chī le fàn yǐhòu, tūrán xiàyǔ le — After we'd eaten, it suddenly rained.

A: 你们有雨衣吗

nǐmen yǒu yǔyī ma — Did you have raincoats?

B: 没有 我们找车的时候 一个老人来了

méiyǒu, wǒmen zhǎo chē de shíhou, yí ge lǎorén lái le — No. While we were looking for the car, an old man came.

A: 第二天呢

dì'èr tiān ne — And the next day?

B: 天气一下子好了 我们看了花 然后回家了

tiānqì yíxiàzi hǎo le, wǒmen kàn le huā, ránhòu huí jiā le — The weather was fine in no time. We looked at the flowers, then went home.

B tells the story from the inside: 我们, not they. The time words still lead each turn.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — telling a day

A story needs a moment, a scene, a turn and a next day:

- 他来的时候 我正在看书 *tā lái de shíhou, wǒ zhèngzài kàn shū* — the moment and the scene.
- 突然下雨了 *tūrán xiàyǔ le* — the turn.
- 天气一下子冷了 *tiānqì yíxiàzi lěng le* — a change that took no time.
- 第二天 *dì'èr tiān* — the day after, inside the story.

Listen. *Nà tiān nǐ zuò shénme le?*
Speak. Tell a day of your own in six lines: a time, what you were doing, what happened, the next day.
Write it: 第二天 and 突然

Your turn

- *Say it:* 那天我正在看书的时候 他突然来了 — *nà tiān wǒ zhèngzài kàn shū de shíhou, tā tūrán lái le* — That day, while I was reading, he suddenly came.
- *Say it:* 第二天天气很好 — *dì'èr tiān tiānqì hěn hǎo* — The next day the weather was fine.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 突然下雨了

Before you move on

Say suddenly it rained. (突然下雨了.) Say when he came, I was eating. (他来的时候 我正在吃饭.) Say the next day. (第二天.)

Chapter 280

What I Think

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I think, and ask what you think.
>
> *Saying what you think with* 我觉得 *and a whole sentence, a suggestion or an objection, as if, and so much, built on one new written character:* 意.

280.1 意见 (yìjiàn) — a suggestion; an objection

A new chapter, and it opens on what people put forward when they disagree.

- *Recall:* say 他突然来了 — *tā tūrán lái le* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *kànfǎ*, a view — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *yǒuyìsi*, interesting — **R3**

You'll want to know: 意见

意见 — *yìjiàn* — "a suggestion; an objection".

> 你有什么意见 *nǐ yǒu shénme yìjiàn* — What do you suggest? Or: what's your objection?

> 我没有意见 *wǒ méiyǒu yìjiàn* — I've no objection; fine by me.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. It is the yì of *yǒuyìsi*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

意见 (*yìjiàn*) is built from 意 'intention' and 见 'to see', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'iH* and *kenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'will, intention' and the second 'to look'; 'a suggestion' or 'an objection' for the pair is the modern word's own sense.

What you've built

kànfǎ is your view of a matter; 意见 is what you put forward about it, and often it is a point against.
It is a noun: you have one, 有意见, or you have none, 没有意见.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìjiàn*
- *Say it: yìjiàn*, once more
- *Say it:* 你有什么意见 — *nǐ yǒu shénme yìjiàn* — What do you suggest?
- *Say it:* 我没有意见 — *wǒ méiyǒu yìjiàn* — I've no objection.
- *Recall:* say *kànfǎ*, then 意见: a view, then a point you put forward

Before you move on

What does 意见 mean? ("A suggestion; an objection".) How do you say you have no objection? (我没有意见.)

280.2 意 — the left of 站 on top, then 日 and 心

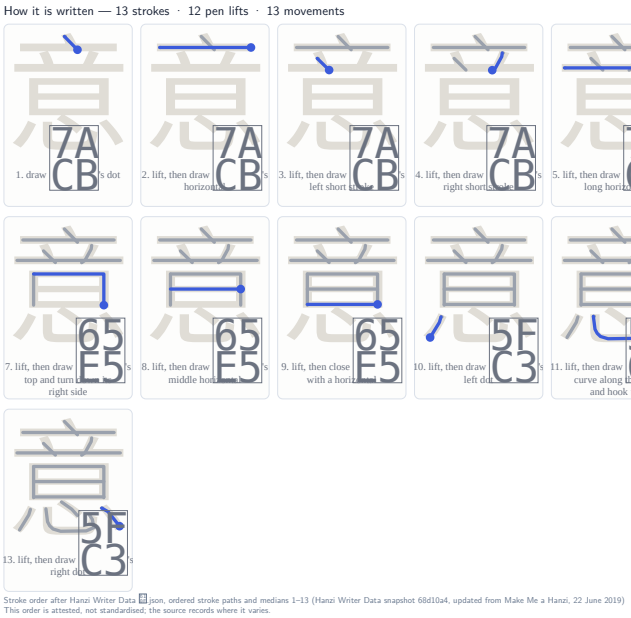
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yìjiàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

站 日 心

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhàn*, *rì*, *xīn*

Script — the left of 站 on top, then 日 and 心



How 意 *is written, stroke by stroke*

意

Three pieces, and you write every one of them already.

The left of 站, five strokes, here on top and wider: the dot, the bar, a dot on the left, a left-falling stroke on the right, and a long horizontal. In 站 that last stroke rises; here it lies flat and runs the whole width.

日, four strokes, in the middle.

心, four strokes, at the foot: the left dot, the curve along the foot that hooks up, the middle dot, the right dot.

5 + 4 + 4 = thirteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 意, all thirteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 意? (**Thirteen.**) Which character you write has the same top? (**站, where it stands on the left.**) What is at the foot? (心.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 意, pinned stroke paths and medians.

280.3 我觉得... — I think

A word you have said for a long time, printed for the first time.

- *Read it:* 意见, aloud — *yìjiàn*
- *Recall:* say *juéde*, to find; to think — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *rènwéi*, to hold a view — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 我觉得 and a whole sentence

我觉得 and then a whole sentence gives your opinion: the sentence after it is what you think.

我觉得他说得对 *wǒ juéde tā shuō de duì* — I think he's right. 我觉得今天太冷了 *wǒ juéde jīntiān tài lěng le* — I find it too cold today.

Both characters of *juéde*, 觉 and 得, are ones you write, so 我觉得 prints in characters now.
To ask, put 你觉得 in front: *nǐ juéde zěnmeyàng?*, what do you think? *rènwéi* says the same more formally, a view you hold and would defend; 我觉得 is the everyday one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我觉得他说得对 — *wǒ juéde tā shuō de duì* — I think he's right.
- 我觉得今天太冷了 — *wǒ juéde jīntiān tài lěng le* — I find it too cold today.
- *nǐ juéde zěnmeyàng* — What do you think?

- what you think of today's weather, with 我觉得

Before you move on

What comes after 我觉得? (**A whole sentence: what you think.**) How do you ask what someone thinks? (*nǐ juéde zěnmeyàng.*)

280.4 hǎoxiàng — as if; to look like

Before the new one: last lesson's opinion, and a word that sounds like this one's end.

- *Read it:* 我觉得今天太冷了, aloud — *wǒ juéde jīntiān tài lěng le*
- *Recall:* say *xiàng*, to be like — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 看来 — *kànlai*, it seems — **R3**

You'll want to know: hǎoxiàng

hǎoxiàng — "as if; to look like", a guess.

tā hǎoxiàng bìng le — He looks as if he's ill.

jīntiān hǎoxiàng yào xiàyǔ — It looks like rain today.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎoxiàng is built from 好 and xiàng 'to be like', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *zjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'good, fine' and the second 'to be like'; 'as if' for the pair is the word's own sense.

What you've built

我觉得 is your opinion. 看来 draws a conclusion from what you see. *hǎoxiàng* is softer still: a guess about how things look.
It goes before the verb, after the person: *tā hǎoxiàng bìng le.*

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎoxiàng*
- *Say it: hǎoxiàng*, once more
- *Say it: tā hǎoxiàng bìng le* — He looks as if he's ill.
- *Say it: jīntiān hǎoxiàng yào xiàyǔ* — It looks like rain today.
- *Recall:* say *xiàng*, then *hǎoxiàng*

Before you move on

What does *hǎoxiàng* mean? ("As if; to look like".) Is it sure? (**No: it is a guess**.)

280.5 这么 (zhème) — so; like this

Before the new one: last lesson's guess, and a word that points the other way.

- *Recall:* say *hǎoxiàng*, as if — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Read it:* 那么, aloud — *nàme*

You'll want to know: 这么

这么 — *zhème* — "so; this much; like this".

今天这么冷 *jīntiān zhème lěng* — It's so cold today!

今天天气这么好 *jīntiān tiānqì zhème hǎo* — The weather's so good today!

Both characters are ones you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

这么 (*zhème*) is built from 这 'this' and the ending 么 of 什么. No dictionary we use records an older form of 这 in this sense, or of the ending, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

那么 points at something over there, as in 他没有你那么高. 这么 points at what is here and now: 今天这么冷.
Both go before an adjective: 这么冷, 这么好.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhème*
- *Say it: zhème*, once more
- *Say it:* 今天这么冷 — *jīntiān zhème lěng* — It's so cold today!
- *Say it:* 今天天气这么好 — *jīntiān tiānqì zhème hǎo* — The weather's so good today!
- *Recall:* say 那么, then 这么: there, then here

Before you move on

What does 这么 mean? ("So; this much".) And 那么? (**So, of something over there**.)

280.6 我觉得这个意见很好

The chapter closes here, with a plan and two people deciding on it.

- *Read it:* 今天这么冷, aloud — *jīntiān zhème lěng*
- *Recall:* say *hǎoxiàng*, as if — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 我没有意见 — *wǒ méiyǒu yìjiàn* — **R2**

The exchange

A: 明天我们去山上 好不好

míngtiān wǒmen qù shān shàng, hǎo bu hǎo — Shall we go up the mountain tomorrow?

B: 我觉得这个意见很好

wǒ juéde zhège yìjiàn hěn hǎo — I think that's a good suggestion.

A: 你们有意见吗

nǐmen yǒu yìjiàn ma — Any objections?

B: *wǒ méiyǒu yìjiàn, tā hǎoxiàng bù xiǎng qù* — None from me. He looks as if he doesn't want to go.

A: 为什么

wèishénme — Why?

B: *wǒ juéde tā tài lèi le* — I think he's too tired.

A: 今天这么冷 明天会冷吗

jīntiān zhème lěng, míngtiān huì lěng ma — It's so cold today. Will it be cold tomorrow?

B: 我觉得不会

wǒ juéde bú huì — I don't think so.

我觉得 answers on its own too: 我觉得不会, I don't think it will. The 不 goes after 我觉得, with the verb it denies.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — giving an opinion

Four ways to say how you see it, from sure to unsure:

- 我觉得他说得对 *wǒ juéde tā shuō de duì* — your opinion.
- 我没有意见 *wǒ méiyǒu yìjiàn* — no objection.
- *tā hǎoxiàng bìng le* — a guess.
- 今天这么冷 *jīntiān zhème lěng* — so cold, here and now.

Listen. *Nǐ juéde míngtiān huì xiàyǔ ma?*

Speak. Give your opinion of a plan for the weekend, and one objection.
Write it: 意见 — the left of 站 on top, then 日, then 心

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我觉得这个意见很好 — *wǒ juéde zhège yìjiàn hěn hǎo* — I think that's a good suggestion.
- *Say it: nǐ juéde zěnmeyàng* — What do you think?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我觉得今天这么冷

Before you move on

Say you think he's right. (我觉得他说得对.) Say you have no objection. (我没有意见.) Say he looks ill. (*tā hǎoxiàng bìng le.*)

Chapter 281

For Example

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give a reason and an example.
>
> *Giving a reason with* 因为 *…* 所以 *… in one sentence, for instance, for this reason and an example, and writing one line of your own with a reason in it, built on two new written characters:* 如 *and* 所*.*

281.1 比如 (bǐrú) — for instance

A new chapter, and it opens on the word that brings in an example.

- *Recall:* say 我觉得这个意见很好 — *wǒ juéde zhège yìjiàn hěn hǎo* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 这么 — *zhème*, so — **R1**
- *Recall:* say 比 — *bǐ*, than — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 比如

比如 — *bǐrú* — "for instance; such as".

> 我喜欢中国菜 比如包子 *wǒ xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài, bǐrú bāozi* — I like Chinese food, steamed buns for instance.

> 我喜欢喝茶 比如中国茶 *wǒ xǐhuan hē chá, bǐrú Zhōngguó chá* — I like tea, Chinese tea for instance.

The next lesson puts the second character in your hand. The first is the 比 you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

比如 (*bǐrú*) is built from 比 'to compare' and 如 'like', both inherited from Middle Chinese. The Guangyun lists 比 under five readings, of which *pjijX* is glossed 'to compare', and 如 under two, *nyo* and *nyoH*; it glosses *nyo* with several words, among them 'to resemble' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'For instance' for the pair is the word's own sense.

What you've built

比如 comes after the general point and before the example: 中国菜, then 比如包子.
It is the 比 of comparing, 比 as in 我比他大, with an example set beside the point.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bǐrú*
- *Say it:* *bǐrú*, once more
- *Say it:* 我喜欢中国菜 比如包子 — *wǒ xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài, bǐrú bāozi* — I like Chinese food, steamed buns for instance.
- *Say it:* 我喜欢喝茶 比如中国茶 — *wǒ xǐhuan hē chá, bǐrú Zhōngguó chá* — I like tea, Chinese tea for instance.
- *Recall:* say 比, then 比如

Before you move on

What does 比如 mean? ("For instance; such as".) Where does it go? (**After the general point, before the example**.)

281.2 如 — 女, then 口

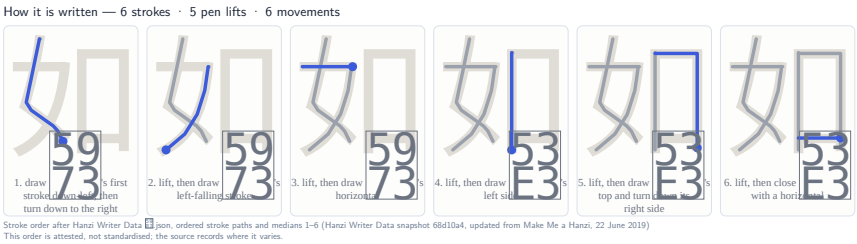
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bǐrú* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  好 妈 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hǎo*, *mā*, *kǒu*

Script — 女, then 口



How 如 *is written, stroke by stroke*

如

Two pieces, and you write both already.

女, three strokes, narrow, on the left, as in 好 and 妈: down to the left and turning down to the right without lifting; a left-falling stroke from the upper right; and a horizontal that rises as it crosses.

口, three strokes, on the right: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the bottom bar.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 如, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 如? (**Six**.) Which piece comes first? (**女, on the left**.) Where else does 女 stand on the left? (**In 好 and 妈**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 如, pinned stroke paths and medians.

281.3 因为...所以... — because, so

Two words you have had for a long time, joined into one frame.

- *Read it:* 比如, aloud — *bǐrú*
- *Recall:* say 因为 — *yīnwèi*, because — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *suǒyǐ*, so — **R3**
- *Recall:* say 为什么 — *wèishénme*, why — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 因为 ... 所以 ..., a reason and what follows

因为 opens the reason, 所以 opens what follows from it, and together they make one sentence.

因为下雨了 所以我们没去 *yīnwèi xiàyǔ le, suǒyǐ wǒmen méi qù* — Because it rained, we didn't go. 因为他病了 所以没来上课 *yīnwèi tā bìng le, suǒyǐ méi lái shàngkè* — He was ill, so he didn't come to class.

You have had 因为 and *suǒyǐ* as separate words; now they frame one sentence, and the next lesson puts 所 in your hand so the frame prints whole.
English keeps one of the two words; Mandarin is happy with both.
To answer 为什么, 因为 alone is enough: 为什么没去 — 因为下雨了 *wèishénme méi qù — yīnwèi xiàyǔ le.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 因为下雨了 所以我们没去 — *yīnwèi xiàyǔ le, suǒyǐ wǒmen méi qù* — Because it rained, we didn't go.
- 因为他病了 所以没来上课 — *yīnwèi tā bìng le, suǒyǐ méi lái shàngkè* — He was ill, so he didn't come to class.
- 为什么没去 — 因为下雨了 — *wèishénme méi qù — yīnwèi xiàyǔ le* — Why didn't you go? Because it rained.
- why you are tired today, with 因为 … 所以 …

Before you move on

Which word opens the reason? (因为.) Which opens what follows? (所以.) How do you answer 为什么 with a reason alone? (因为**, and the reason**.)

281.4 所 — two four-stroke sides

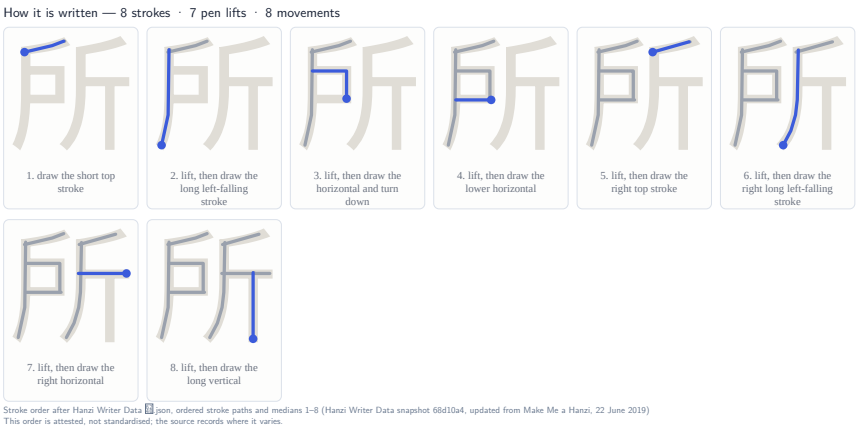
The sentence first, then the character it was waiting for.

- *Recall:* say 因为下雨了 所以我们没去 — *yīnwèi xiàyǔ le, suǒyǐ wǒmen méi qù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

房 以

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *fáng, yǐ*

Script — two four-stroke sides



How 所 *is written, stroke by stroke*

所

Two sides of four strokes each, and both are new in this shape.

The left side, four strokes: a short, flat left-falling stroke at the top; a long left-falling stroke down the left side; a horizontal that turns down at

its right end; and a horizontal under it. It looks like the top of 房, but 房 opens with a dot, and this opens with a short left-falling stroke.

The right side, four strokes: a flat left-falling stroke at the top; a long left-falling stroke that drops down and then curves to the lower left; a horizontal across it; and a long vertical down to the foot.

4 + 4 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 所, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 所? (**Eight**.) How does the left side begin? (**With a short left-falling stroke, not the dot of 房**.) Which stroke comes last? (**The long vertical on the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 所, pinned stroke paths and medians.

281.5 yīncǐ — for this reason

Before the new one: the character you wrote last, and the word it sits in.

- *Read it:* 所以, aloud — *suǒyǐ*
- *Recall:* say 因为下雨了 所以我们没去 — *yīnwèi xiàyǔ le, suǒyǐ wǒmen méi qù* — **R1**, two lessons back

You'll want to know: yīncǐ

yīncǐ — "for this reason; and so".

tiānqì bù hǎo, yīncǐ wǒmen méi qù — The weather was bad, and so we didn't go.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīncǐ is built from 因 and cǐ 'this', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jin* and *tshjeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to rely on' and 'a cause', and the second 'to stop'; 'this' is not given there, and 'for this reason' for the pair is the word's own sense.

What you've built

suǒyǐ is the everyday so. *yīncǐ* belongs to writing and careful speech, and it usually stands on its own, with no 因为 in front.
It opens the result, after the reason: *tiānqì bù hǎo, yīncǐ wǒmen méi qù.*

Your turn

- *Say it: yīncǐ*
- *Say it: yīncǐ*, once more
- *Say it: tiānqì bù hǎo, yīncǐ wǒmen méi qù* — The weather was bad, and so we didn't go.
- *Recall:* say *suǒyǐ*, then *yīncǐ*: the everyday so, then the careful one

Before you move on

What does *yīncǐ* mean? ("For this reason".) Where does it belong? (**In writing and careful speech**.)

281.6 lìzi — an example

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and the word that brings an example in.

- *Recall:* say *yīncǐ*, for this reason — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Read it:* 比如, aloud — *bǐrú*

You'll want to know: lìzi

lìzi — "an example".

qǐng shuō yí ge lìzi — Please give an example.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lìzi is built from lì 'a precedent' and the ending 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljejH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to compare' and 'all'; 'an example' is the modern word's own sense.

What you've built

比如 brings an example in; *lìzi* is the example itself, a noun you can count: *yí ge lìzi*.
So a teacher asks *qǐng shuō yí ge lìzi*, and you answer with 比如 ….

Your turn

- *Say it: lìzi*
- *Say it: lìzi*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng shuō yí ge lìzi* — Please give an example.
- *Say it:* 比如包子 — *bǐrú bāozi* — Steamed buns, for instance.
- *Recall:* say 比如, then *lìzi*: bringing one in, then the example itself

Before you move on

What does *lìzi* mean? ("An example".) How do you ask for one? (*qǐng shuō yí ge lìzi*.)

281.7 One reason — a line of your own with 因为 and 所以

Someone asks you a question you have surely been asked before: 你为什么学汉语?

This lesson answers it, in one line of your own.

- *Recall:* say *lìzi*, an example

Writing — controlled composition

Write **one line** that answers 你为什么学汉语. Use the frame: 因为 and your reason, then 所以 and 我学汉语. If you want to add an example, 比如 brings it in at the end.

A word whose characters you have not written goes in pinyin, inside the line, with its tone marks: 中国菜 is all characters you write, but *kěyǐ* has one you do not write yet, so it goes in pinyin. Every character comes from the ones you have learned, each in the order you learned it, each in the same size of square.

No Chinese commas or full stops: leave a space between the two halves, as this book prints them.

Write the line. Then read it back: is 因为 in front of the reason, and 所以 in front of what follows?

Before you move on

Which half of your line could stand alone as the answer to 为什么? (**The half with** 因为.)
Which character did you write for the first time this chapter, inside your line? (所**, in** 所以.)

281.8 因为我喜欢中国 所以学汉语

The chapter closes here, with the question your own line answered.

- *Recall:* say *lìzi*, an example — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *yīncǐ*, for this reason — **R2**
- *Read it:* 如, aloud — *rú*, the second half of 比如

The exchange

A: 你为什么学汉语

nǐ wèishénme xué Hànyǔ — Why are you learning Chinese?

B: 因为我喜欢中国 所以学汉语

yīnwèi wǒ xǐhuan Zhōngguó, suǒyǐ xué Hànyǔ — I like China, so I'm learning Chinese.

A: 你喜欢中国的什么

nǐ xǐhuan Zhōngguó de shénme — What do you like about China?

B: 中国菜 中国茶

Zhōngguó cài, Zhōngguó chá — Chinese food, Chinese tea.

A: *nǐ néng shuō yí ge lìzi ma* — Can you give an example?

B: 比如包子 我很喜欢

bǐrú bāozi, wǒ hěn xǐhuan — Steamed buns, for one. I love them.

A: *wǒ yě shì, yīncǐ wǒ xiǎng qù Zhōngguó* — Me too, and so I want to go to China.

因为 … 所以 … gives the reason and the result in one breath; 比如 then backs it up. The line with *yīncǐ* sounds a little careful, as that word does.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — a reason and an example

A reason, what follows from it, and something to show it:

- 因为下雨了 所以我们没去 *yīnwèi xiàyǔ le, suǒyǐ wǒmen méi qù* — the reason and the result.
- *tiānqì bù hǎo, yīncǐ wǒmen méi qù* — the careful version.
- 中国菜 比如包子 *Zhōngguó cài, bǐrú bāozi* — an example brought in.
- *qǐng shuō yí ge lìzi* — asking for one.

Listen. *Nǐ wèishénme xué Hànyǔ?*

Speak. Give two reasons for something you do every week, each with 因为 … 所以 ….
Write it: 所以 and 比如

Your turn

- *Say it:* 因为我病了 所以我今天不去上课 — *yīnwèi wǒ bìng le, suǒyǐ wǒ jīntiān bú qù shàngkè* — I'm ill, so I'm not going to class today.
- *Say it:* 为什么 — 因为我喜欢中国 — *wèishénme* — *yīnwèi wǒ xǐhuan Zhōngguó* — Why? Because I like China.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 因为我病了 所以没去

Before you move on

Say because it rained, we didn't go. (因为下雨了 所以我们没去.)
Say steamed buns, for instance. (比如包子.) Ask for an example. (*qǐng shuō yí ge lìzi.*)

Chapter 282

You Should Rest

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what someone should or had better do.
>
> *Giving advice with* 应该 *and* 不应该*, saying it is time with* 该*, what is wise with* 最好 *and what cannot be helped with děi, built on two new written characters:* 该 *and* 应*.*

282.1 该 (gāi) — it's time to

A new chapter, and it opens on the moment when something has to happen.

- *Recall:* say 因为我喜欢中国 所以学汉语 — *yīnwèi wǒ xǐhuan Zhōngguó, suǒyǐ xué Hànyǔ* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *lìzi*, an example — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *xiūxi*, to rest — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 该

该 — *gāi* — "it's time to; should (by now)".

> 我该回家了 *wǒ gāi huí jiā le* — It's time I went home.
>
> 该你了 *gāi nǐ le* — Your turn.

The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

该 (*gāi*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *koj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'complete' and 'all'. 'Should' and 'it's time to' are not given there, so how the word came by them is not settled.

What you've built

With 了 at the end, 该 says the moment has come: 我该回家了, 该你了.
It sits before the verb, after the person, where 要 and 想 sit.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāi*
- *Say it: gāi*, once more
- *Say it:* 我该回家了 — *wǒ gāi huí jiā le* — It's time I went home.
- *Say it:* 该你了 — *gāi nǐ le* — Your turn.
- *Recall:* say *xiūxi*, then *wǒ gāi xiūxi le*: time I rested

Before you move on

What does 该 mean? ("It's time to; should".) What closes 我该回家了? (了**: the moment has come**.)

282.2 该 — the left of 说, then the right of 孩

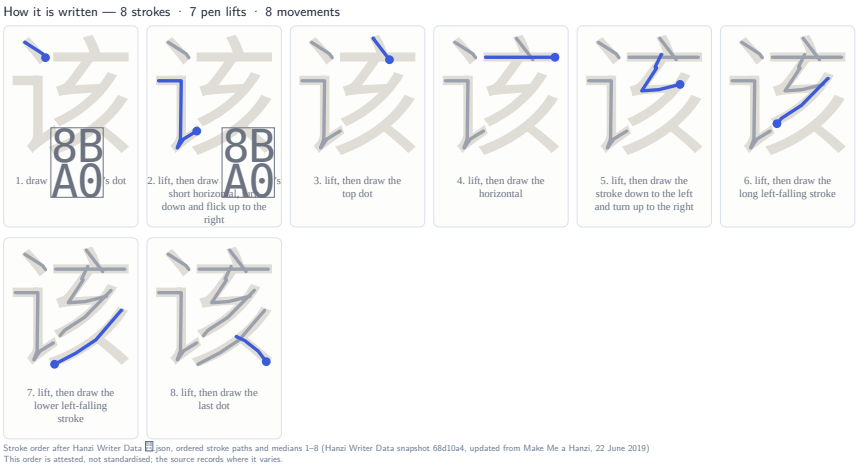
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gāi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  说 孩

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shuō*, *hái*

Script — the left of 说, then the right of 孩



How 该 *is written, stroke by stroke*

该

Two pieces, and you write both already.

The left of 说, two strokes: a dot, then a short horizontal that turns down and flicks up to the right.

The right of 孩, six strokes: a dot at the top; a horizontal under it; a stroke that falls to the lower left and turns up to the right; a long left-falling stroke; a shorter left-falling stroke under it; and a dot at the lower right.

2 + 6 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 该, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 该? (**Eight**.) Where have you written its left side? (**On 说**.) And its right side? (**On 孩**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 该, pinned stroke paths and medians.

282.3 应该 (yīnggāi) — should; ought to

Before the new one: the character you wrote last, in the sentence it belongs to.

- *Read it:* 我该回家了, aloud — *wǒ gāi huí jiā le*
- *Recall:* say 医生 — *yīshēng*, a doctor — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 应该

应该 — *yīnggāi* — "should; ought to".

你应该去看医生 *nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng* — You should see a doctor.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. The second is the 该 you wrote last.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

应该 (*yīnggāi*) is built from 应 and 该, both inherited from Middle Chinese. The Guangyun lists 应 under two readings: *'ing*, glossed with a word that can mean 'ought to', and *'ingH*, glossed 'things answering each other'; yīng is the first. 该 is *koj*, glossed 'complete' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

该 says the moment has come; 应该 gives advice, or says what is right. Both sit before the verb: 你应该去看医生 *nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng*. 看医生 is to see a doctor.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yīnggāi*
- *Say it:* *yīnggāi*, once more
- *Say it:* 你应该去看医生 — *nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng* — You should see a doctor.
- *Recall:* say 该, then 应该: it's time, then you should

Before you move on

What does 应该 mean? ("Should; ought to".) How is it different from 该? (**该 says it's time; 应该 gives advice.**)

282.4 应 — the roof of 店, two dots, a falling stroke and a base

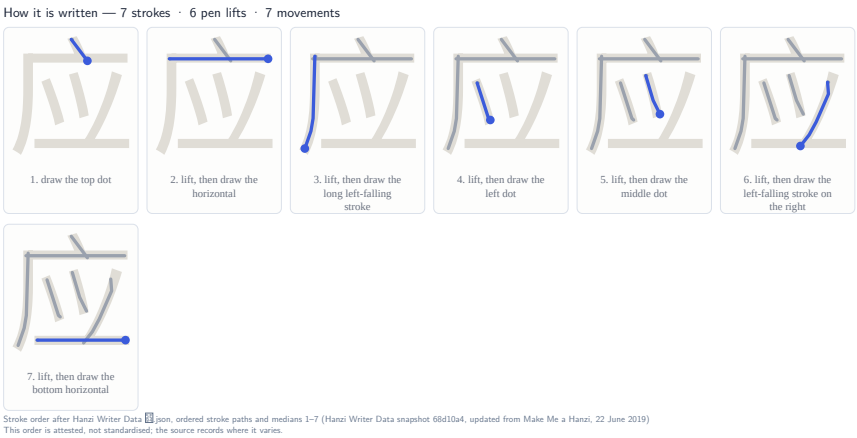
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yīnggāi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  店 点

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *diàn*, *diǎn*

Script — the roof of 店, two dots, a falling stroke and a base



How 应 is written, stroke by stroke

应

Two pieces, and you write the first already.
The roof of 店, three strokes: the dot on top, the bar, and a long left-falling stroke down the left side.

Under it, four strokes: a dot on the left, a dot in the middle, a left-falling stroke on the right, and last a long horizontal along the foot.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 应, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 应? (**Seven**.) Which character you write has the same roof? (店.) Which stroke comes last? (**The long horizontal along the foot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 应, pinned stroke paths and medians.

282.5 你应该... — you should

A word you have, and the advice it gives.

- *Read it:* 应该, aloud — *yīnggāi*
- *Recall:* say 我该回家了 — *wǒ gāi huí jiā le* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *zěnme bàn*, what should I do — **R3**, durable

Grammar Lens: 应该 and 不应该, advice and what is right

应该 before a verb gives advice, or says what is right; 不应该 says what is not.

你应该去看医生 *nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng* — You should see a doctor. 你不应该这么晚回家 *nǐ bù yīnggāi zhème wǎn huí jiā* — You shouldn't come home so late.

不 goes in front of 应该, and stays *bù* before the level yīng. 晚 here is late, the 晚 of 晚上.
To ask for advice: *wǒ yīnggāi zěnme bàn?*, what should I do?
该 says the time has come; 应该 says what is right, whatever the time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 你应该去看医生 — *nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng* — You should see a doctor.
- 你不应该这么晚回家 — *nǐ bù yīnggāi zhème wǎn huí jiā* — You shouldn't come home so late.
- *wǒ yīnggāi zěnme bàn* — What should I do?
- one piece of advice for a friend who is ill

Before you move on

Where does 应该 go? (**Before the verb**.) How do you say someone shouldn't? (不应该**, said *bù yīnggāi*.**)

282.6 最好 (zuìhǎo) — had better

Before the new one: advice, and the character it starts with.

Read these aloud:

- 你不应该这么晚回家, aloud — *nǐ bù yīnggāi zhème wǎn huí jiā*
- 最后, aloud — *zuìhòu*

You'll want to know: 最好

最好 — *zuìhǎo* — "had better; it would be best to".

> 你最好早点儿回家 *nǐ zuìhǎo zǎo diǎnr huí jiā* — You'd better go home early.
>
> *nǐ zuìhǎo bié qù* — You'd better not go.

Every character in it is one you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

最好 (*zuìhǎo*) is built from 最 'most' and 好 'good', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tswajH* and *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'utmost' and 'good'. 'Best' is the plain sum of the two; 'had better' is the word's own use.

What you've built

应该 says what is right; 最好 says what is wise, the best of the choices. It goes where 应该 goes, before the verb: 你最好早点儿回家 *nǐ zuìhǎo zǎo diǎnr huí jiā*.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuìhǎo*
- *Say it: zuìhǎo*, once more
- *Say it:* 你最好早点儿回家 — *nǐ zuìhǎo zǎo diǎnr huí jiā* — You'd better go home early.
- *Say it: nǐ zuìhǎo bié qù* — You'd better not go.
- *Recall:* say 最后, then 最好: the same 最, two words

Before you move on

What does 最好 mean? ("Had better".) Where does it go? (**Before the verb, where 应该 goes**.)

282.7 děi — to have to

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and a character you know in another job.

- *Recall:* say 最好 — *zuìhǎo*, had better — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Read it:* 你说得很好, aloud — *nǐ shuō de hěn hǎo*

You'll want to know: děi

děi — "to have to; must".

> 我得回家了 *wǒ děi huí jiā le* — I have to go home now.
>
> 明天我得去上课 *míngtiān wǒ děi qù shàngkè* — I have to go to class tomorrow.

It is written 得, the character of 说得好, but it is a different word with its own sound, *děi*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

děi is written with 得, which is inherited from Middle Chinese *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to get'. *děi* is not the regular modern sound of *tok*, and 'to have to' is not given there; how the character came to write this word is not settled.

What you've built

应该 is advice, 最好 is what is wise, and *děi* leaves no choice: 我得回家了.
So 得 in a sentence has two sounds: *de* after a verb, as in 说得好, and *děi* before one, as here.

Your turn

- *Say it: děi*
- *Say it: děi*, once more
- *Say it:* 我得回家了 — *wǒ děi huí jiā le* — I have to go home now.
- *Say it:* 明天我得去上课 — *míngtiān wǒ děi qù shàngkè* — I have to go to class tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say 你说得很好, then 我得回家了: *de*, then *děi*

Before you move on

What does *děi* mean? ("To have to".) How is 得 said in 说得好? (**de, light**.) And in 我得回家了? (**děi**.)

282.8 你病了 应该去看医生

The chapter closes here, with a friend who is not well and wants to go to class.

- *Recall:* say 我得回家了 — *wǒ děi huí jiā le* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 最好 — *zuìhǎo* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *hǎoxiàng*, as if — **R3**

The exchange

A: *wǒ hǎoxiàng bìng le* — I think I'm ill.

B: 你应该去看医生

nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng — You should see a doctor.

A: 我得去上课

wǒ děi qù shàngkè — I have to go to class.

B: 你病了 不应该去上课

nǐ bìng le, bù yīnggāi qù shàngkè — You're ill. You shouldn't go to class.

A: 那我该做什么

nà wǒ gāi zuò shénme — Then what should I do?

B: 你最好在家

nǐ zuìhǎo zài jiā — You'd better stay at home.

A: 好 我该回家了

hǎo, wǒ gāi huí jiā le — All right. Time I went home.

Four words of advice and duty, in rising order of force: 最好 is wise, 应该 is right, 该 says the time has come, *děi* allows no choice.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — advice and duty

Four words before the verb, each with its own force:

- 你应该去看医生 *nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng* — what is right.
- 你最好在家 *nǐ zuìhǎo zài jiā* — what is wise.
- 我该回家了 *wǒ gāi huí jiā le* — the time has come.
- 我得去上课 *wǒ děi qù shàngkè* — no choice.

Listen. *Nǐ juéde wǒ yīnggāi qù ma?*
Speak. Give a friend two pieces of advice about the weekend, one with 应该 and one with 最好.
Write it: 应该 — the roof of 店 first, then the right of 孩 after the left of 说

Your turn

- *Say it:* 你病了 应该在家 — *nǐ bìng le, yīnggāi zài jiā* — You're ill; you should stay at home.
- *Say it:* 你最好早点儿回家 — *nǐ zuìhǎo zǎo diǎnr huí jiā* — You'd better go home early.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 你应该去看医生

Before you move on

Say you should see a doctor. (你应该去看医生.) Say you'd better stay at home. (你最好在家.) Say it's time you went home. (我该回家了.)

Chapter 283

Which Way?

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask the way and follow simple directions.
>
> *Asking the way with* 去 … 怎么走*, following directions with wǎng, saying again with* 再 *and passing by on the way, built on two new written characters:* 怎 *and* 走*.*

283.1 怎么 (zěnme) — how

A new chapter, and it opens on the word you ask a stranger with.

- *Recall:* say 你应该去看医生 — *nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *zěnmeyàng*, how is it — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *zěnme bàn*, what should I do — **R3**

You'll want to know: 怎么

怎么 — *zěnme* — "how; in what way".

> 这个字怎么写 *zhège zì zěnme xiě* — How do you write this character?
>
> 汉语怎么说 *Hànyǔ zěnme shuō* — How do you say it in Chinese?

You have said it inside *zěnmeyàng* and *zěnme bàn*; here it stands alone, before a verb. The next lesson puts the first character in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

怎么 (*zěnme*) is built from 怎 'how' and the ending 么 of 什么. No dictionary we use records an older form of either, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

怎么 goes right before the verb it asks about: 怎么写, 怎么说.
The answer shows the way, or gives it: 这么写, written like this.

Your turn

- *Say it: zěnme*
- *Say it: zěnme*, once more
- *Say it:* 这个字怎么写 — *zhège zì zěnme xiě* — How do you write this character?
- *Say it:* 汉语怎么说 — *Hànyǔ zěnme shuō* — How do you say it in Chinese?
- *Recall:* say *zěnmeyàng*, then 怎么: how is it, then how

Before you move on

What does 怎么 mean? ("How".) Where does it go? (**Right before the verb**.)

283.2 怎 — the right of 作, then 心

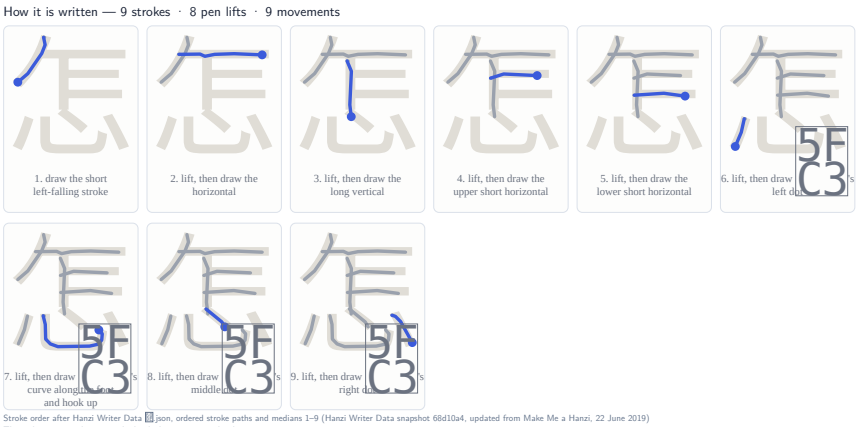
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zěnme* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

作 心

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zuò*, *xīn*

Script — the right of 作, then 心



How 怎 is written, stroke by stroke

怎

Two pieces, and you write both already.

The right of 作, five strokes, here on top: a short left-falling stroke; a horizontal from it to the right; a long vertical down from the horizontal; then two short horizontals to its right, the upper one first.

心, four strokes, at the foot: the left dot, the curve along the foot that hooks up, the middle dot, the right dot.

5 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 怎, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 怎? (**Nine.**) Where have you written its top? (**On the right of 作.**) What is at the foot? (心.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 怎, pinned stroke paths and medians.

283.3 去...怎么走 — how do I get there?

The word you wrote last, and a verb you have said for a long time.

- *Read it:* 怎么, aloud — *zěnme*
- *Recall:* say *zǒu*, to walk — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 火车站 — *huǒchēzhàn*, the station — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 去 ... 怎么走, asking the way

去, the place, then 怎么走 asks the way there.

去火车站怎么走 *qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the station? 请问 去书店怎么走 *qǐngwèn, qù shūdiàn zěnme zǒu* — Excuse me, how do I get to the bookshop?

走 is the *zǒu* you know, to walk; the next lesson puts it in your hand.
请问 in front makes the question polite.
The answer shows the way: *yìzhí zǒu*, straight on; *dào lùkǒu zuǒ guǎi*, turn left at the crossing. zuǒ is the zuǒ of *zuǒbian*; yòu, the yòu of *yòubian*, turns you right.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 去火车站怎么走 — *qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the station?
- 请问 去书店怎么走 — *qǐngwèn, qù shūdiàn zěnme zǒu* — Excuse me, how do I get to the bookshop?
- *yìzhí zǒu, dào lùkǒu yòu guǎi* — Straight on, and turn right at the crossing.
- ask the way to a place in your own town

Before you move on

How do you ask the way to the station? (去火车站怎么走.) What does *yìzhí zǒu* tell you? (**Straight on**.)

283.4 走 — 土, then four strokes along the foot

The question first, then the character it was waiting for.

- *Recall:* say 去火车站怎么走 — *qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  在 正

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zài*, *zhèng*

Script — 土, then four strokes along the foot

How 走 *is written, stroke by stroke*

走

Two pieces, and you write the first already.
土, three strokes, on top, as at the lower right of 在: a short horizontal, a vertical down through it, and a longer horizontal.

The lower piece, four strokes: a short vertical; a short horizontal to its right, the way the lower part of 正 begins; a left-falling stroke to the lower left; and last the long sweep along the foot to the right.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 走, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 走? (**Seven**.) Where have you written its top? (**At the lower right of 在**.) Which stroke comes last? (**The long sweep along the foot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 走, pinned stroke paths and medians.

283.5 wǎng — towards

Before the new one: the question, and the two sides of the street.

- *Read it:* 去火车站怎么走, aloud — *qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu*
- *Recall:* say *zuǒbian*, the left — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *yòubian*, the right — **R3**

You'll want to know: wǎng

wǎng — "towards; in the direction of".

wǎng qián zǒu — Go straight ahead.

dào lùkǒu wǎng zuǒ guǎi — At the crossing, turn left.

Its character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǎng is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to go' and 'to go to'; its use as 'towards' is not given there.

What you've built

wǎng comes before a direction, and the verb follows: *wǎng qián zǒu*, *wǎng zuǒ guǎi*, *wǎng yòu guǎi*.
qián is the 前 of 前边: ahead.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎng*
- *Say it: wǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǎng qián zǒu* — Go straight ahead.
- *Say it: dào lùkǒu wǎng zuǒ guǎi* — At the crossing, turn left.
- *Recall:* say *wǎng yòu guǎi*: turn right

Before you move on

What does *wǎng* mean? ("Towards".) What comes after it? (**A direction, then the verb**.)

283.6 再 (zài) — again

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and a goodbye you have said from the first chapters.

- *Recall:* say *wǎng qián zǒu*, straight ahead — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 再见 — *zàijiàn*, goodbye — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 再

再 — *zài* — "again; once more", for what is still to come.

我明天再来 *wǒ míngtiān zài lái* — I'll come again tomorrow.

qǐng zài shuō yí cì — Please say it once more.

It is the 再 of 再见: see you again.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

再 (*zài*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'twice; a second time'.

What you've built

再 goes before the verb, after the person, and it looks forward: the again has not happened yet.
It is not the 在 of 我在家: the same sound, a different word, a different character.

Your turn

- *Say it: zài*
- *Say it: zài*, once more
- *Say it:* 我明天再来 — *wǒ míngtiān zài lái* — I'll come again tomorrow.
- *Say it: qǐng zài shuō yí cì* — Please say it once more.
- *Recall:* say 再见, then 我明天再来

Before you move on

What does 再 mean? ("Again", still to come.) Which 在 is it not? (**The 在 of place,** 我在家.)

283.7 路过 (lùguò) — to pass by

Before the new one: last lesson's word, then two characters you write.

- *Read it:* 我明天再来, aloud — *wǒ míngtiān zài lái*

  路 过

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lù*, *guò*

You'll want to know: 路过

路过 — *lùguò* — "to pass by", on the way somewhere else.

我每天路过学校 *wǒ měitiān lùguò xuéxiào* — I go past the school every day.

我路过你家 *wǒ lùguò nǐ jiā* — I'm going past your house.

Both characters are ones you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

路过 (*lùguò*) is built from 路 'road' and 过 'to pass', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luH* and *kwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a road' and the second, among other senses, 'to go beyond'.

What you've built

路过 is passing a place on your way somewhere else: you do not stop there. 去 is going there.
It is a verb, and the place follows it: 路过学校.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùguò*
- *Say it: lùguò*, once more
- *Say it:* 我每天路过学校 — *wǒ měitiān lùguò xuéxiào* — I go past the school every day.

- *Say it:* 我路过你家 — *wǒ lùguò nǐ jiā* — I'm going past your house.
- *Recall:* say 路, then 过, then 路过

Before you move on

What does 路过 mean? ("To pass by".) Do you stop at the place? (**No: it is on the way**.)

283.8 去书店怎么走

The chapter closes here, with a stranger asking the way.

- *Recall:* say 路过 — *lùguò* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 再 — *zài*, again — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *wǎng*, towards — **R2**

The exchange

A: 请问 去书店怎么走

qǐngwèn, qù shūdiàn zěnme zǒu — Excuse me, how do I get to the bookshop?

B: *wǎng qián zǒu* — Go straight ahead.

B: *dào lùkǒu wǎng yòu guǎi* — Turn right at the crossing.

A: *duìbuqǐ, qǐng zài shuō yí cì* — Sorry, could you say that again?

B: *wǎng qián zǒu, dào lùkǒu wǎng yòu guǎi* — Straight ahead, then right at the crossing.

A: *yuǎn ma* — Is it far?

B: *bù yuǎn, wǒ měitiān lùguò* — Not far. I go past it every day.

A: 谢谢 再见

xièxie, zàijiàn — Thank you. Goodbye.

Directions run in the order you walk them, and the person is left out: *wǎng qián zǒu*, then *dào lùkǒu wǎng yòu guǎi*. Asking again is *qǐng zài shuō yí cì*.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — asking the way, and following it

A question, three answers, and a way to hear them twice:

- 去火车站怎么走 *qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu* — the question.
- *wǎng qián zǒu* — straight ahead.
- *dào lùkǒu wǎng zuǒ guǎi* — left at the crossing.
- 我每天路过 *wǒ měitiān lùguò* — I pass it every day.
- *qǐng zài shuō yí cì* — once more, please.

Listen. *Qù xuéxiào zěnme zǒu?*
Speak. Give the way from your door to the nearest shop, in three steps.
Write it: 怎么走

Your turn

- *Say it:* 去书店怎么走 — *qù shūdiàn zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the bookshop?
- *Say it: wǎng qián zǒu, dào lùkǒu wǎng yòu guǎi* — Straight ahead, then right at the crossing.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 去火车站怎么走

Before you move on

Ask the way to the bookshop. (去书店怎么走.) Say go straight ahead. (*wǎng qián zǒu.*) Ask someone to say it again. (*qǐng zài shuō yí cì.*)

Chapter 284

Two Tickets

Modes: **voice** (8) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can buy a ticket and say how I am travelling.
>
> *Saying how you travel with* 坐 *…* 去*, buying and returning tickets, platforms, one-way tickets and seats,* 在 *after a verb for where something lands, and* 家 *for counting shops, built on one new written character:* 坐*.*

284.1 zhàntái — a platform

A new chapter, and it opens at the station, where the trains stand.

- *Recall:* say 去书店怎么走 — *qù shūdiàn zěnme zǒu* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 路过 — *lùguò*, to pass by — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 火车 — *huǒchē*, a train — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 火车站 — *huǒchēzhàn*, a station — **R3**

You'll want to know: zhàntái

zhàntái — "a platform", at a station.

> *huǒchē zài èr hào zhàntái* — The train is at platform two.

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhàntái is built from 站 and tái 'a raised platform'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which the dictionary gives as the everyday word for standing alone. tái is written with a character whose traditional form is *doj*, glossed as a raised square of earth; the simplified character is also an old one in its own right, with the readings *yi* and *thoj* and other senses.

What you've built

zhàntái holds the 站 of 火车站: the station, and the platform you stand on in it.
A number comes before 号: *èr hào zhàntái*, platform two.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhàntái*
- *Say it: zhàntái*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē zài èr hào zhàntái* — The train is at platform two.
- *Recall:* say 火车站, then *zhàntái*

Before you move on

What does *zhàntái* mean? ("A platform".) How do you say platform two? (*èr hào zhàntái*.)

284.2 坐火车去 — going by train

A verb you have said since the early chapters, and the ticket that goes with it.

- *Recall:* say *zhàntái*, a platform — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *zuò*, to sit; to travel by — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 票 — *piào*, a ticket — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *zhāng*, the measure word for flat things — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 坐 and a vehicle, then 去

坐 and a vehicle, then 去 or 来: that is how you travel.

我们坐火车去 *wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù* — We're going by train. 我们坐八点的火车 *wǒmen zuò bā diǎn de huǒchē* — We're taking the eight o'clock train.

坐 is the *zuò* you know, to sit and to travel by; the next lesson puts it in your hand. The vehicle comes between 坐 and the verb of going. Tickets are counted with *zhāng*, as flat things are: *mǎi liǎng zhāng qù Běijīng de piào*, two tickets to Beijing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我们坐火车去 — *wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù* — We're going by train.
- 我们坐八点的火车 — *wǒmen zuò bā diǎn de huǒchē* — We're taking the eight o'clock train.
- *mǎi liǎng zhāng qù Běijīng de piào* — Two tickets to Beijing, please.
- how you get to work or school, with 坐 … 去

Before you move on

Where does the vehicle go? (**Between 坐 and 去.**) What counts tickets? (*zhāng*, as for flat things.)

284.3 坐 — 人 twice, then 土

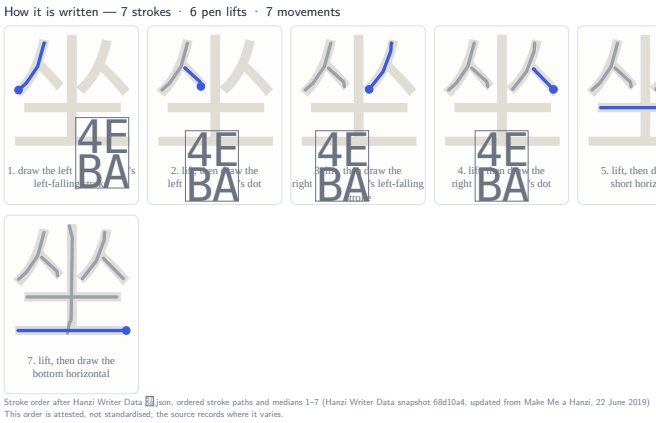
The sentence first, then the character it was waiting for.

- *Recall:* say 我们坐火车去 — *wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  人 从 在

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *cóng*, *zài*

Script — 人 twice, then 土



How 坐 is written, stroke by stroke

坐

Three pieces, and you write all of them already.

人, twice, side by side, the left one first. Each is a left-falling stroke and then a dot: neither has the long right-falling stroke of 人 standing alone.

土, three strokes, under them, as at the lower right of 在: the short horizontal; then the vertical, from the top between the two 人, down through it; then the long horizontal along the foot.

2 + 2 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 坐, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 坐? (**Seven.**) What shrinks to a dot in each 人? (**The second stroke.**) Where does the vertical of 土 start? (**At the top, between the two 人.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 坐, pinned stroke paths and medians.

284.4 dānchéng — one way

Before the new one: the train you are taking, and how you count its tickets.

- *Read it:* 我们坐八点的火车, aloud — *wǒmen zuò bā diǎn de huǒchē*
- *Recall:* say *mǎi liǎng zhāng piào*, two tickets — **R2**

You'll want to know: dānchéng

dānchéng — "one way", of a ticket or a trip.

yì zhāng dānchéng piào — a one-way ticket

dānchéng háishi wǎngfǎn — One way or return?

wǎngfǎn, there and back, is the other choice. Its characters come later; for now *dānchéng* is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dānchéng is built from dān 'single' and chéng, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tan* and *drjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'single, not double' and the second 'a term; a limit'; 'one way' for the pair, a single stage of a journey, is the word's own sense.

What you've built

At the window you are asked *dānchéng háishi wǎngfǎn?*, one way or return. 还是 is the or of a question.
Answer with the word alone: *dānchéng.*

Your turn

- *Say it: dānchéng*
- *Say it: dānchéng*, once more
- *Say it: yì zhāng dānchéng piào* — a one-way ticket
- *Say it: dānchéng háishi wǎngfǎn* — One way or return?
- *Recall:* answer the question: *dānchéng*

Before you move on

What does *dānchéng* mean? ("One way".) What is the other choice? (*wǎngfǎn*, there and back.)

284.5 zuòwèi — a seat

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and the character you wrote this chapter.

- *Recall:* say *dānchéng*, one way — **R1**, one lesson back

  坐

Read it: it aloud, with nothing said first — *zuò*

You'll want to know: zuòwèi

zuòwèi — "a seat".

zhèr yǒu zuòwèi ma — Is there a seat here?

Its characters come later. The first is not the 坐 you write but one that shares its sound and holds it under a roof.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuòwèi is built from zuò 'a seat' and wèi 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzwaH* and *hwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the stand of a bed' and 'a position; a rank'.

What you've built

坐 is the verb, to sit; *zuòwèi* is the noun, the seat itself: *wǒ de zuòwèi zài nǎr?*, where's my seat?

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòwèi*
- *Say it: zuòwèi*, once more

- *Say it: zhèr yǒu zuòwèi ma* — Is there a seat here?
- *Say it: wǒ de zuòwèi zài nǎr* — Where's my seat?
- *Recall:* say 坐, then *zuòwèi*: to sit, then the seat

Before you move on

What does *zuòwèi* mean? ("A seat".) Is its first character the 坐 you write? (**No: the same sound, another character**.)

284.6 tuìpiào — to return a ticket

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and one you use at a hotel desk.

- *Recall:* say *zuòwèi*, a seat — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *tuìfáng*, to check out — **R3**, durable

  票

Read it: it aloud, with nothing said first — *piào*

You'll want to know: tuìpiào

tuìpiào — "to return a ticket", for your money back.

wǒ xiǎng tuìpiào — I'd like to return my ticket.

Its first character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuìpiào is built from tuì 'to give back' and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *thwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to draw back'; the dictionary has no entry for 票, so that part's history is not settled.

What you've built

You know *tuìfáng*, to give back a hotel room; *tuìpiào* gives back a ticket the same way.

It is a verb on its own, with the ticket inside it: *wǒ xiǎng tuìpiào.*

Your turn

- *Say it: tuìpiào*
- *Say it: tuìpiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng tuìpiào* — I'd like to return my ticket.
- *Recall:* say *tuìfáng*, then *tuìpiào*

Before you move on

What does *tuìpiào* mean? ("To return a ticket".) Which word gives back a hotel room? (*tuìfáng.*)

284.7 坐在这儿 — 在 after the verb

A word you have used since the first chapters, in a new place in the sentence.

- *Recall:* say *tuìpiào*, to return a ticket — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 我在家 — *wǒ zài jiā*, I'm at home — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *zhù*, to live — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *fàng*, to put — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 在 after the verb, for where the action lands

在 after a verb says where the action lands, or where it stays.

你坐在这儿 *nǐ zuò zài zhèr* — You sit here. *tā zhù zài xuéxiào lǐ* — He lives at the school.

Keep it apart from 在 before the verb: 我在家吃饭 says where the eating happens. After the verb, 在 marks where you end up sitting, living or putting something: *fàng zài zhèr*, put it here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 你坐在这儿 — *nǐ zuò zài zhèr* — You sit here.
- *tā zhù zài xuéxiào lǐ* — He lives at the school.
- *fàng zài zhèr* — Put it here.
- where you live, with *zhù zài*

Before you move on

Where does 在 go in 你坐在这儿? (**After the verb**.) What does it say there? (**Where the sitting lands**.)

284.8 一家书店 — counting shops with 家

A word you wrote in the first chapters, doing a new job.

- *Read it:* 你坐在这儿, aloud — *nǐ zuò zài zhèr*
- *Recall:* say 书店 — *shūdiàn*, a bookshop — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *bīnguǎn*, a hotel — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 家 for counting shops

家 after a number, or after 这 or 那, counts shops, hotels and restaurants.

这家书店很好 *zhè jiā shūdiàn hěn hǎo* — This bookshop is very good. 那家饭店的菜很好吃 *nà jiā fàndiàn de cài hěn hǎochī* — The food at that restaurant is delicious.

一家书店, a bookshop; *liǎng jiā bīnguǎn*, two hotels. It is the 家 of home, now counting places that do business: 家, not 个, is the measure word to use for them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 这家书店很好 — *zhè jiā shūdiàn hěn hǎo* — This bookshop is very good.
- 那家饭店的菜很好吃 — *nà jiā fàndiàn de cài hěn hǎochī* — The food at that restaurant is delicious.
- *liǎng jiā bīnguǎn* — two hotels
- the name of a shop you like, with 这家

Before you move on

What does 家 count? (**Shops, hotels and restaurants**.) Which measure word do you use for a bookshop, 家 or 个? (家.)

284.9 我们坐八点的火车

The chapter closes here, at the ticket window.

- *Read it:* 这家书店很好, aloud — *zhè jiā shūdiàn hěn hǎo*
- *Recall:* say *tuìpiào*, to return a ticket — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *zuòwèi*, a seat — **R2**

The exchange

A: *wǒ yào liǎng zhāng qù Běijīng de piào* — Two tickets to Beijing, please.

B: *dānchéng háishi wǎngfǎn* — One way or return?

A: *dānchéng, wǒmen zuò bā diǎn de huǒchē* — One way. We're taking the eight o'clock train.

B: *bā diǎn de huǒchē zài èr hào zhàntái* — The eight o'clock is at platform two.

A: *yǒu zuòwèi ma* — Are there seats?

B: 有

yǒu — There are.

A: 车站里有一家书店吗

chēzhàn lǐ yǒu yì jiā shūdiàn ma — Is there a bookshop in the station?

B: *yǒu, zài zhàntái qiánbian* — There is, in front of the platform.

The answers are short: *dānchéng*, 有. The station's bookshop is counted with 家, and the platform has a number before 号.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — getting on a train

Everything you need between the window and your seat:

- 我们坐火车去 *wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù* — how you travel.
- *mǎi liǎng zhāng piào, dānchéng, tuìpiào* — buying, and giving back.
- *èr hào zhàntái, zuòwèi* — where to go, and where to sit.
- 你坐在这儿 *nǐ zuò zài zhèr* — where you land.
- 一家书店 *yì jiā shūdiàn* — a shop, counted.

Listen. *Nǐmen zuò jǐ diǎn de huǒchē?*
Speak. Buy a ticket for a trip you would like to take: where, how many, one way or return.
Write it: 坐火车 — 人 twice, then the foot of 在

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我们坐八点的火车 — *wǒmen zuò bā diǎn de huǒchē* — We're taking the eight o'clock train.

- *Say it: wǒ yào liǎng zhāng qù Běijīng de piào* — Two tickets to Beijing, please.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我们坐火车去

Before you move on

Say you're going by train. (我们坐火车去.) Ask for one-way. (*dānchéng*.) Tell someone to sit here. (你坐在这儿.)

Chapter 285

Lost on the Way

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 6 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can report a lost thing and write a short note about it.
>
> *Reporting a problem with …不见了, saying you can't find it with* 找不到*, papers, reporting a loss and getting in touch, and writing four connected lines to a hotel desk.*

285.1 找回 (zhǎohuí) — to get back

A new chapter, and it opens on the happy end of a bad day.

- *Recall:* say 我们坐八点的火车 — *wǒmen zuò bā diǎn de huǒchē* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 找 — *zhǎo*, to look for — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 找到 — *zhǎodào*, to find — **R3**
- *Recall:* say 回 — *huí*, to go back — **R3**

You'll want to know: 找回

找回 — *zhǎohuí* — "to get back", something you had lost.

> 我找回了我的手机 *wǒ zhǎohuí le wǒ de shǒujī* — I got my phone back.

Both characters are ones you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

找回 (*zhǎohuí*) is built from 找 'to look for' and 回 'to go back'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to turn round'; the dictionary has no entry for 找, so the history of that part is not settled.

What you've built

找 is to look for, 找到 is to find, and 找回 is to find what you had lost and have it again.
了 after it says it is done: 我找回了我的手机.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎohuí*
- *Say it: zhǎohuí*, once more
- *Say it:* 我找回了我的手机 — *wǒ zhǎohuí le wǒ de shǒujī* — I got my phone back.
- *Recall:* say 找, then 找到, then 找回

Before you move on

What does 找回 mean? ("To get back".) And 找到? (**To find**.)

285.2 我的手机不见了 — it's gone

Every word in it is one you have; together they report a problem.

- *Read it:* 找回, aloud — *zhǎohuí*
- *Recall:* say *diū*, to lose — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 手机 — *shǒujī*, a phone — **R3**

Grammar Lens: ...不见了, it has gone missing

Name the thing, then say 不见了: it has gone missing.

我的手机不见了 *wǒ de shǒujī bú jiàn le* — My phone's gone missing. 我的车票不见了 你看到了吗 *wǒ de chēpiào bú jiàn le, nǐ kàndào le ma* — My ticket's disappeared. Have you seen it?

不见 is 'not seen', and 了 says that is new: it was there, and now it is not. 不 before the fall of jiàn is *bú*.
diū le says you lost it yourself: *wǒ de qiánbāo diū le. huài le* says it broke. *qǐng bāng wǒ*, please help me, asks for help.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我的手机不见了 — *wǒ de shǒujī bú jiàn le* — My phone's gone missing.
- 我的车票不见了 你看到了吗 — *wǒ de chēpiào bú jiàn le, nǐ kàndào le ma* — My ticket's disappeared. Have you seen it?
- *qǐng bāng wǒ* — Please help me.
- something of yours that went missing once, with 不见了

Before you move on

What comes after the thing? (不见了.) How is 不 said there? (*bú*, before the fall of jiàn.)

285.3 zhèngjiàn — papers; an identity document

Before the new one: last lesson's problem, and two things you hope never to lose.

- *Read it:* 我的手机不见了, aloud — *wǒ de shǒujī bú jiàn le*
- *Recall:* say *hùzhào*, a passport — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *shēnfènzhèng*, an identity card — **R3**

You'll want to know: zhèngjiàn

zhèngjiàn — "papers; an identity document".

wǒ de zhèngjiàn bú jiàn le — My papers have gone missing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhèngjiàn is built from zhèng 'proof' and jiàn 'an item', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyingH* and *gjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, under its traditional form, 'to verify' and the second 'a portion'.

What you've built

hùzhào and *shēnfènzhèng* are both *zhèngjiàn*: it is the word for any of them, the one a desk asks to see.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngjiàn*
- *Say it: zhèngjiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de zhèngjiàn bú jiàn le* — My papers have gone missing.
- *Recall:* say *hùzhào*, then *zhèngjiàn*: one of them, then any of them

Before you move on

What does *zhèngjiàn* mean? ("Papers; an identity document".) Is a passport one? (**Yes**.)

285.4 guàshī — to report a loss

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and two words that share its sounds.

- *Recall:* say *zhèngjiàn*, papers — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *guà*, to hang — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *shīwàng*, disappointed — **R3**

You'll want to know: guàshī

guàshī — "to report the loss of" a card or a document.

> *wǒ yào guàshī wǒ de xìnyòngkǎ* — I need to report my credit card lost.
>
> *wǒ děi qù guàshī* — I have to go and report it lost.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guàshī is built from guà 'to hang' and shī 'to lose', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kweaH* and *syit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hang' and the second 'to let slip'. 'To report a loss' for the pair is its own sense, which neither gloss gives.

What you've built

guàshī is what you do at a bank or a police desk once a card or a passport is gone, so nobody else can use it.
The thing follows it: *guàshī wǒ de xìnyòngkǎ*.

Your turn

- *Say it: guàshī*
- *Say it: guàshī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào guàshī wǒ de xìnyòngkǎ* — I need to report my credit card lost.
- *Say it: wǒ děi qù guàshī* — I have to go and report it lost.
- *Recall:* say *guà*, then *guàshī*

Before you move on

What does *guàshī* mean? ("To report a loss".) What follows it? (**The thing that was lost**.)

285.5 liánxì — to get in touch

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and how you reach people now.

- *Recall:* say *guàshī*, to report a loss — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 打电话 — *dǎ diànhuà*, to phone — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *hàomǎ*, a number — **R3**

You'll want to know: liánxì

liánxì — "to get in touch with; to contact".

wǒ zěnme liánxì nǐ — How can I get in touch with you?

qǐng gēn wǒ liánxì — Please get in touch with me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liánxì is built from lián 'to join' and xì 'to tie'. The Guangyun has no entry for the first under the traditional forms we look it up by, so the history of that part is not settled; the second is written with a character that stands for two traditional ones. The Guangyun reads one *kejH*, glossed 'joined together', and lists the other under two readings, *kejH*, glossed 'to tie up', and *hejH*, given only as the name of a part of the Book of Changes (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The senses sit with *kejH*, but xì is not its regular modern sound, which would be jì: the change of sound is irregular.

What you've built

打电话 is one way to *liánxì*; a message is another. The person you reach follows it, or comes before it with gēn: *qǐng gēn wǒ liánxì*.

Your turn

- *Say it: liánxì*
- *Say it: liánxì*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ zěnme liánxì nǐ* — How can I get in touch with you?
- *Say it: qǐng gēn wǒ liánxì* — Please get in touch with me.
- *Recall:* say 打电话, then *liánxì*: one way, then any way

Before you move on

What does *liánxì* mean? ("To get in touch".) How do you ask how to reach someone? (*wǒ zěnme liánxì nǐ*.)

285.6 找不到 — can't find it

Verbs with a result after them, which you have; and a way to say the result is out of reach.

- *Recall:* say *liánxì*, to get in touch — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 找到 — *zhǎodào*, to find — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *tīngdǒng*, to understand what you hear — **R3**
- *Recall:* say 看到 — *kàndào*, to see — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 找不到 and 找得到, can't and can

不 between a verb and its result says you can't manage it; 得 there says you can.

我找不到我的手机 *wǒ zhǎo bu dào wǒ de shǒujī* — I can't find my phone. *wǒ tīng bu dǒng* — I can't understand what's being said.

找到, 看到, *tīngdǒng*: you know verbs with a result after them. Put 不 in the middle, said light, and the result is out of reach: 找不到. Put 得 there, also light, and it is within reach: 你找得到吗 *nǐ zhǎo de dào ma*? Keep to the results *dào*, *dǒng* and *wán* for now: *zuò bu wán*, more than you can finish.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我找不到我的手机 — *wǒ zhǎo bu dào wǒ de shǒujī* — I can't find my phone.
- *wǒ tīng bu dǒng* — I can't understand what's being said.
- 你找得到吗 — *nǐ zhǎo de dào ma* — Can you find it?
- something you can't find today, with 找不到

Before you move on

What does 不 do in 找不到? (**Puts the result out of reach: can't find.**) And 得 in 找得到? (**Puts it within reach: can find.**)

285.7 A note to the desk, four lines that lean on each other

You are staying at a hotel, and something of yours has gone missing. The front desk, *qiántái*, can help, if you tell them clearly.

This lesson writes to them.

- *Recall:* say *liánxì*, to get in touch — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *qiántái*, the front desk — **R3**, durable

What to know first

A note is connected when each line leans on the one before. Four short lines can hang together; four long ones can fall apart.

Three things do the leaning, and you own all three. **The time words lead**: 早上, 回来的时候, 明天. **The subject is said once**: 我 in the first line, and the lines after it start on the time or the verb. **Each line answers the question the last one raised**: gone, when, what now, how to reach you.

Your reader is the desk. Your purpose is to get the thing back.

Writing — connected composition

Write **four lines** to the front desk. No name at the top: begin as you would at the desk.

- Line 1 says what is gone, with 不见了.
- Line 2 says when you last had it, with 的时候.
- Line 3 says what you need, with 请, or what you think you should do, with 我应该.
- Line 4 says how to reach you: *liánxì*, and a time or a room number.

A word whose characters you have not written goes in pinyin, inside the line, with its tone marks: *liánxì*, *qiántái*, *hùzhào*. Every character comes from the ones you have learned, each in the order you learned it, each in the same size of square.

No Chinese commas or full stops: leave a space between clauses, as this book prints them.

Write the note. Then read it once as the desk would, top to bottom: could they act on it?

Before you move on

Read your second line on its own. Does it stand up without the first? (**It should not quite: it says when, and the first says what**.) Count the lines that start with 我. If every one does, you wrote a list, not a note.

285.8 我的车票不见了

The chapter closes here, on a train, with two things missing.

- *Recall:* say *guàshī*, to report a loss — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *zhèngjiàn*, papers — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 我找回了我的手机 — *wǒ zhǎohuí le wǒ de shǒujī* — **R2**

The exchange

A: 我的车票不见了

wǒ de chēpiào bú jiàn le — My ticket's gone.

B: 你找了吗

nǐ zhǎo le ma — Have you looked for it?

A: 找了 我找不到

zhǎo le, wǒ zhǎo bu dào — I have. I can't find it.

B: 你上车的时候有吗

nǐ shàngchē de shíhou yǒu ma — Did you have it when you got on?

A: 有 我坐在这儿的时候还有

yǒu, wǒ zuò zài zhèr de shíhou hái yǒu — Yes. I still had it when I sat down here.

B: *nǐ yīnggāi liánxì chēzhàn* — You should get in touch with the station.

A: *wǒ de zhèngjiàn yě bú jiàn le* — My papers are gone too.

B: *nà nǐ děi măshàng guàshī* — Then you'll have to report them lost straight away.

A answers with the verb alone, 找了, and B leads with the moment, 你上车的时候. 还有 says A still had it then.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — when something goes missing

What to say, from the bad news to the end of it:

- 我的车票不见了 *wǒ de chēpiào bú jiàn le* — it's gone.
- 我找不到 *wǒ zhǎo bu dào* — I can't find it.
- *guàshī, liánxì* — report it, and leave a way to reach you.
- 我找回了我的手机 *wǒ zhǎohuí le wǒ de shǒujī* — and, with luck, it comes back.

Listen. *Nǐ de shénme bú jiàn le?*
Speak. Report something missing at a desk, in four sentences: what, when, what you need, how to reach you.
Write it: 不见了 and 找不到

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我的车票不见了 你看到了吗 — *wǒ de chēpiào bú jiàn le, nǐ kàndào le ma* — My ticket's disappeared. Have you seen it?
- *Say it:* 我找不到我的手机 — *wǒ zhǎo bu dào wǒ de shǒujī* — I can't find my phone.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我的手机不见了

Before you move on

Say your ticket has gone. (我的车票不见了.) Say you can't find it. (我找不到.) Say you got your phone back. (我找回了我的手机.)

Chapter 286

How It Felt

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how something felt and how long it lasted.
>
> *Saying how something felt with* 我感觉 *and a feeling, how long it lasted with the length after the verb, how long and what a pity, built on one new written character:* 感.

286.1 感觉 (gǎnjué) — to feel; a feeling

A new chapter, and it opens on how things felt.

- *Recall:* say 我的车票不见了 — *wǒ de chēpiào bú jiàn le* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say *gǎndào*, to feel — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 开心 — *kāixīn*, happy — **R3**

You'll want to know: 感觉

感觉 — *gǎnjué* — "to feel", how something seems to you; "a feeling".

我感觉很好 *wǒ gǎnjué hěn hǎo* — I feel fine.

wǒ gǎnjué tā bù gāoxìng — I have a feeling he's not happy.

The next lesson puts the first character in your hand. The second is the 觉 of *juéde*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

感觉 (*gǎnjué*) is built from 感 and 觉, both inherited from Middle Chinese. 感 is *komX*, glossed 'to move, to stir'. The Guangyun lists 觉 under two readings: *kaewH*, glossed as sleep, and *kaewk*, glossed 'to understand' and 'to wake'; jué is the regular modern sound of *kaewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'To feel' for the pair is the word's own sense.

What you've built

gǎndào and 感觉 both report a feeling; 感觉 is also how something seems to you: 我感觉很好.
juéde, as in 我觉得, is what you think about it.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnjué*
- *Say it: gǎnjué*, once more
- *Say it:* 我感觉很好 — *wǒ gǎnjué hěn hǎo* — I feel fine.
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué tā bù gāoxìng* — I have a feeling he's not happy.
- *Recall:* say 我觉得, then 我感觉: what I think, then how it feels

Before you move on

What does 感觉 mean? ("To feel; a feeling".) Which word gives an opinion instead? (觉得.)

286.2 感 — a frame with 口 inside, then 心

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gǎnjué* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  我 口 心

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wǒ*, *kǒu*, *xīn*

Script — a frame with 口 inside, then 心

How 感 is written, stroke by stroke

感

Two pieces: a frame with 口 inside it, then 心.

The frame, nine strokes: a long horizontal at the top; a left-falling stroke down the left side; a short horizontal under the top; 口, three strokes, small, under that; then the long slanting hook down to the lower right, as in 我; a short left-falling stroke across it; and last the dot at the top right.

心, four strokes, at the foot: the left dot, the curve along the foot that hooks up, the middle dot, the right dot.

9 + 4 = thirteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 感, all thirteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 感? (**Thirteen**.) Where have you written the slanting hook? (**In** 我.) What is at the foot? (心.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 感, pinned stroke paths and medians.

286.3 我感觉... — how it felt

A word you have, and the feelings that go after it.

- *Read it:* 感觉, aloud — *gǎnjué*
- *Recall:* say *nánguò*, sad — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *jǐnzhāng*, nervous — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *shīwàng*, disappointed — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 我感觉 and a feeling

我感觉 and a feeling word says how it felt; the feeling words are ones you know.

那天我感觉很开心 *nà tiān wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn* — I felt really happy that day. *shàngkè de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn jǐnzhāng* — I felt nervous in class.

The feeling takes 很, as it does after 我: 我感觉很开心. Any feeling you know fits: *gāoxìng*, *nánguò*, *jǐnzhāng*, *jīdòng*, *shīwàng*.
感觉 is for how it felt; 觉得 is for what you think. 我觉得他说得对 is an opinion; 我感觉很好 is a feeling.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 那天我感觉很开心 — *nà tiān wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn* — I felt really happy that day.
- *shàngkè de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn jǐnzhāng* — I felt nervous in class.
- how you felt on your last birthday, with 我感觉

Before you move on

What comes after 我感觉? (**A feeling, with 很.**) Which word gives an opinion instead? (觉得.)

286.4 学了两年 — how long it lasted

Numbers you know, and a new place to put them.

- *Read it:* 那天我感觉很开心, aloud — *nà tiān wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn*
- *Recall:* say 年 — *nián*, a year — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *hǎojiǔ*, a long time — **R3**
- *Recall:* say 多大 — *duō dà*, how old — **R3**

Grammar Lens: the length after the verb

How long something lasted goes after the verb and its 了; with an object, the object comes after the length.

我学了两年汉语 *wǒ xué le liǎng nián Hànyǔ* — I studied Chinese for two years. *tā zài Zhōngguó zhù le yì nián* — He lived in China for a year.

When it happened goes before the verb: 上个月. How long it lasted goes after: 一个月.
To ask, put 多 before 长, as you put it before 大 in 多大: 你学了多长时间 *nǐ xué le duō cháng shíjiān*?

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我学了两年汉语 — *wǒ xué le liǎng nián Hànyǔ* — I studied Chinese for two years.
- *tā zài Zhōngguó zhù le yì nián* — He lived in China for a year.
- 你学了多长时间 — *nǐ xué le duō cháng shíjiān* — How long did you study?

- how long you have been learning Chinese, with 了 and the length

Before you move on

Where does the length go? (**After the verb and 了.**) And the object? (**After the length: 两年汉语.**)

286.5 duōjiǔ — how long

Before the new one: last lesson's question, and an answer you already have.

- *Read it:* 你学了多长时间, aloud — *nǐ xué le duō cháng shíjiān*
- *Recall:* say *hǎojiǔ*, a long time — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: duōjiǔ

duōjiǔ — "how long", of time.

nǐ xué le duōjiǔ — How long did you study?

nǐ zài Zhōngguó zhù le duōjiǔ — How long did you live in China?

Its second character comes later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duōjiǔ is built from 多 'much' and jiǔ 'long-lasting', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ta* and *kjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'many' and the second 'lasting long'.

What you've built

duōjiǔ asks what 多长时间 asks, in fewer words, and it takes the same place, after the verb.
hǎojiǔ answers it: a long time.

Your turn

- *Say it: duōjiǔ*
- *Say it: duōjiǔ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ xué le duōjiǔ* — How long did you study?
- *Say it: nǐ zài Zhōngguó zhù le duōjiǔ* — How long did you live in China?
- *Recall:* say 多长时间, then *duōjiǔ*: the long question, then the short one

Before you move on

What does *duōjiǔ* mean? ("How long".) Which longer question means the same? (多长时间.)

286.6 yíhàn — a pity

Before the new one: last lesson's question, and two words for when things go wrong.

- *Recall:* say *duōjiǔ*, how long — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *hòuhuǐ*, to regret — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *shīwàng*, disappointed — **R3**

You'll want to know: yíhàn

yíhàn — "a pity; regrettable".

tài yíhàn le — What a pity!

wǒ méi qù, hěn yíhàn — I didn't go, which is a shame.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yíhàn is built from yí 'to leave behind' and hàn 'resentment', both inherited from Middle Chinese. The Guangyun lists the first under two

readings, *ywij*, glossed 'to lose', 'to be gone' and 'to give', and *ywijH*, glossed 'to give'; the second is *homH*, glossed 'resentment' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'A pity' for the pair is the modern word's own sense.

What you've built

hòuhuǐ is regretting what you did yourself; *yíhàn* is a pity, whoever was to blame.
It takes 很 or 太 … 了, as a feeling does: *tài yíhàn le*.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíhàn*
- *Say it: yíhàn*, once more
- *Say it: tài yíhàn le* — What a pity!
- *Say it: wǒ méi qù, hěn yíhàn* — I didn't go, which is a shame.
- *Recall:* say *hòuhuǐ*, then *yíhàn*: my fault, then a pity

Before you move on

What does *yíhàn* mean? ("A pity".) How do you say what a pity? (*tài yíhàn le*.)

286.7 我感觉很好

The chapter closes here, with someone back from a year away.

- *Recall:* say *yíhàn*, a pity — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *duōjiǔ*, how long — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 我学了两年汉语 — *wǒ xué le liǎng nián Hànyǔ* — **R2**

The exchange

A: 你去过中国吗

nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma — Have you been to China?

B: 去过 我在中国学了一年汉语

qù guo, wǒ zài Zhōngguó xué le yì nián Hànyǔ — I have. I studied Chinese there for a year.

A: *nǐ gǎnjué zěnmeyàng* — How did it feel?

B: 我感觉很好

wǒ gǎnjué hěn hǎo — It felt good.

A: *nǐ zài Zhōngguó zhù le duōjiǔ* — How long did you live there?

B: 一年

yì nián — A year.

A: 你想再去吗

nǐ xiǎng zài qù ma — Do you want to go again?

B: *xiǎng, méiyǒu shíjiān, tài yíhàn le* — I do, but there's no time. What a pity.

A asks with 过, then with 感觉, then with *duōjiǔ*; B answers each in as few words as will do: 去过, 一年.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — how it was

How it felt, how long it lasted, and how you feel about it now:

- 那天我感觉很开心 *nà tiān wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn* — how it felt.

- 我学了两年汉语 *wǒ xué le liǎng nián Hànyǔ* — how long.
- *nǐ xué le duōjiǔ?* — asking how long.
- *tài yíhàn le* — a pity.

Listen. *Nǐ zài nàr zhù le duōjiǔ?*
Speak. Tell someone about a place you stayed: how long, and how it felt.
Write it: 感觉 — the frame with 口, then 心

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我在中国学了一年汉语 感觉很好 — *wǒ zài Zhōngguó xué le yì nián Hànyǔ, gǎnjué hěn hǎo* — I studied Chinese in China for a year, and it felt good.
- *Say it:* 你学了多长时间 — *nǐ xué le duō cháng shíjiān* — How long did you study?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我感觉很好

Before you move on

Say you feel fine. (我感觉很好.) Say you studied Chinese for two years. (我学了两年汉语.) Say what a pity. (*tài yíhàn le.*)

Chapter 287

What I Want to Be

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I want to do or be later.
>
> *Saying what you want to do or be with* 以后我想 *and* 当*, a dream and a goal, and* 最 *before* 喜欢 *or an adjective, built on one new written character:* 当.

287.1 当 (dāng) — to work as

A new chapter, and it opens on the job you might do one day.

- *Recall:* say 我感觉很好 — *wǒ gǎnjué hěn hǎo* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 医生 — *yīshēng*, a doctor — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say *lǎoshī*, a teacher — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *dāngshí*, at that time — **R3**

You'll want to know: 当

当 — *dāng* — "to work as; to be", in a job or a role.

> 我想当医生 *wǒ xiǎng dāng yīshēng* — I want to be a doctor.
>
> *tā dāng le liǎng nián lǎoshī* — He worked as a teacher for two years.

The next lesson puts it in your hand. It is the dāng of *dāngshí*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当 (*dāng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the character under two readings, *tang* and *tangH*, and glosses *tang* 'to match', 'to face' and 'to be in charge'; 'to work as' is not given there, so how the word came by it is not settled.

What you've built

当 takes a job or a role after it: 当医生, *dāng lǎoshī*.
With a length of time, it follows the pattern you have: *dāng le liǎng nián lǎoshī*.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāng*
- *Say it: dāng*, once more
- *Say it:* 我想当医生 — *wǒ xiǎng dāng yīshēng* — I want to be a doctor.
- *Say it: tā dāng le liǎng nián lǎoshī* — He worked as a teacher for two years.
- *Recall:* say *dāngshí*, then 当: the same syllable

Before you move on

What does 当 mean? ("To work as; to be".) What follows it? (**A job or a role**.)

287.2 当 — the top of 常, then the foot of 雪

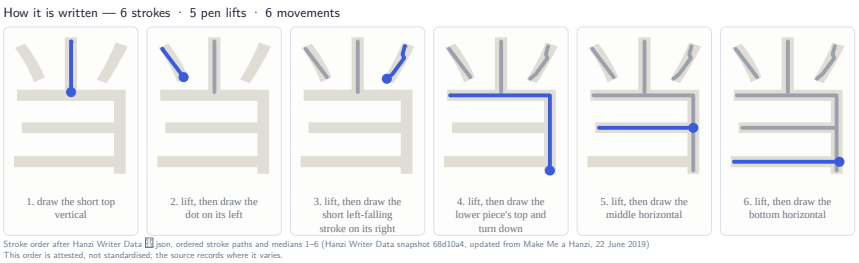
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dāng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  常 雪

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *cháng*, *xuě*

Script — the top of 常, then the foot of 雪



How 当 is written, stroke by stroke

当

Two pieces, and you write both already.

Three short strokes on top, as on top of 常: the short vertical in the middle first, then the dot to its left, then the short left-falling stroke to its right.

Three horizontals joined on the right, as at the foot of 雪: a horizontal that turns down at its right end, a horizontal across the middle, and a horizontal along the foot.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 当, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 当? (**Six**.) Which stroke comes first? (**The short vertical in the middle**.) Where have you written its lower piece? (**At the foot of 雪**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 当, pinned stroke paths and medians.

287.3 以后我想... — later, I want to

Words you have, put together to look ahead.

- *Read it:* 我想当医生, aloud — *wǒ xiǎng dāng yīshēng*
- *Recall:* say *jiānglái*, in the future — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 以后 — *yǐhòu*, later — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 以后 and 想, looking ahead

A time word for later, then 想 or 要, says what you want to do or be.

以后我想去中国工作 *yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng qù Zhōngguó gōngzuò* — Later on I want to go and work in China. 以后你想当什么 *yǐhòu nǐ xiǎng dāng shénme* — What do you want to be later on?

以后 here is later, some time to come, at the front of the sentence. *jiānglái* reaches further: some day, in the future.
想 is a wish; 要 is a plan you mean to keep, as in 下个月我要去中国.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 以后我想去中国工作 — *yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng qù Zhōngguó gōngzuò* — Later on I want to go and work in China.
- 以后你想当什么 — *yǐhòu nǐ xiǎng dāng shénme* — What do you want to be later on?
- *wǒ xiǎng dāng lǎoshī* — I want to be a teacher.
- what you want to do later on, with 以后 and 想

Before you move on

Where does 以后 go? (**At the front**.) Which says a wish, 想 or 要? (想.)

287.4 mèngxiǎng — a dream for your life

Before the new one: last lesson's plan, and a word for what happens in sleep.

- *Read it:* 以后我想去中国工作, aloud — *yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng qù Zhōngguó gōngzuò*
- *Recall:* say *zuòmèng*, to dream — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: mèngxiǎng

mèngxiǎng — "a dream", the one you have for your life.

wǒ de mèngxiǎng shì dāng yīshēng — My dream is to be a doctor.

Its first character comes later. The second is the 想 you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mèngxiǎng is built from mèng 'a dream' and 想 'to think', both inherited from Middle Chinese. The Guangyun lists the first under two readings, *mjuwng* and *mjuwngH*, and under the second describes the spirit wandering in sleep; 想 is *sjangX*, glossed 'to think' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

zuòmèng is dreaming in your sleep; *mèngxiǎng* is the dream you have for your life.
It is a noun, and 是 links it to the dream itself: *wǒ de mèngxiǎng shì …*.

Your turn

- *Say it: mèngxiǎng*
- *Say it: mèngxiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de mèngxiǎng shì dāng yīshēng* — My dream is to be a doctor.
- *Recall:* say *zuòmèng*, then *mèngxiǎng*: asleep, then awake

Before you move on

What does *mèngxiǎng* mean? ("A dream for your life".) And *zuòmèng*? (**To dream in your sleep**.)

287.5 mùbiāo — a goal

Before the new one: last lesson's word, and one that shares this word's first sound.

- *Recall:* say *mèngxiǎng*, a dream for your life — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *jiémù*, a programme — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: mùbiāo

mùbiāo — "a goal; a target".

wǒ de mùbiāo shì shuō hǎo Hànyǔ — My goal is to speak Chinese well.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mùbiāo is built from mù 'the eye' and biāo 'a mark', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjuwk* and *pjiew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the eye' and the second 'to raise' and 'the tip of a tree'. 'A goal' for the pair is its own sense.

What you've built

mèngxiǎng is what you hope for; *mùbiāo* is what you aim at, and can reach step by step.

Your turn

- *Say it: mùbiāo*
- *Say it: mùbiāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de mùbiāo shì shuō hǎo Hànyǔ* — My goal is to speak Chinese well.
- *Recall:* say *mèngxiǎng*, then *mùbiāo*: the hope, then the aim

Before you move on

What does *mùbiāo* mean? ("A goal".) How is it different from *mèngxiǎng*? (**A goal is something you aim at and can reach**.)

287.6 我最喜欢... — the one I like best

A word you have said for a long time, printed for the first time.

- *Recall:* say *mùbiāo*, a goal — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *zuì*, most — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 他比我大 — *tā bǐ wǒ dà* — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 最, the most of all

最 before 喜欢 or an adjective picks out the top of the group.

我最喜欢中国菜 *wǒ zuì xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài* — I like Chinese food best. 这家书店最大 *zhè jiā shūdiàn zuì dà* — This bookshop is the biggest.

zuì you have said since the chapter on order; now it prints. 比 sets two things side by side, 我比他大; 最 needs no second thing: it is the most of all.
The story on the mountain ended on it: 那天是我最开心的一天.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 我最喜欢中国菜 — *wǒ zuì xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài* — I like Chinese food best.
- 这家书店最大 — *zhè jiā shūdiàn zuì dà* — This bookshop is the biggest.
- 那天是我最开心的一天 — *nà tiān shì wǒ zuì kāixīn de yì tiān* — That was my happiest day.
- the food you like best, with 我最喜欢

Before you move on

Where does 最 go? (**Before 喜欢 or an adjective**.) Does it need a second thing, as 比 does? (**No**.)

287.7 以后我想当医生

The chapter closes here, with a question every child is asked.

- *Read it:* 我最喜欢中国菜, aloud — *wǒ zuì xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài*
- *Recall:* say *mùbiāo*, a goal — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *mèngxiǎng*, a dream — **R2**

The exchange

A: 以后你想当什么

yǐhòu nǐ xiǎng dāng shénme — What do you want to be later on?

B: 我想当医生

wǒ xiǎng dāng yīshēng — I want to be a doctor.

A: 为什么

wèishénme — Why?

B: 因为我妈妈是医生

yīnwèi wǒ māma shì yīshēng — Because my mother is a doctor.

A: *nǐ de mèngxiǎng shì shénme* — What's your dream?

B: *wǒ de mèngxiǎng shì qù Zhōngguó gōngzuò* — My dream is to work in China.

A: 你去过中国吗

nǐ qù guo Zhōngguó ma — Have you been to China?

B: 去过 我最喜欢中国菜

qù guo, wǒ zuì xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài — I have. I like Chinese food best.

当 answers 当什么; 因为 answers 为什么; and B's last line looks back with 过 before it looks forward again.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — looking ahead

What you want, what you dream of, what you aim at, and what you like best:

- 以后我想当医生 *yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng dāng yīshēng* — a wish for later.
- *wǒ de mèngxiǎng shì …* — a dream.
- *wǒ de mùbiāo shì …* — a goal.
- 我最喜欢中国菜 *wǒ zuì xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài* — the best of all.

Listen. *Yǐhòu nǐ xiǎng zuò shénme gōngzuò?*
Speak. Say what you want to be or do later, and one goal on the way.
Write it: 当 — the top of 常, then the foot of 雪

Your turn

- *Say it:* 我去过中国 以后我想在中国工作 — *wǒ qù guo Zhōngguó, yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng zài Zhōngguó gōngzuò* — I've been to China, and later on I want to work there.
- *Say it:* 以后你想当什么 — *yǐhòu nǐ xiǎng dāng shénme* — What do you want to be later on?
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 我想当医生

Before you move on

Say you want to be a doctor. (我想当医生.) Ask what someone wants to be later on. (以后你想当什么.) Say what you like best. (我最喜欢....)

Chapter 288

If It Rains

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what will happen if something else does.
>
> *Saying what will happen if something else does with* 要是 … 就 … *and* … 的话*, and what it depends on with* 看*, built on one new written character:* 就.

288.1 就 (jiù) — then; right away

A new chapter, and it opens on the small word that joins what comes next to what came first.

- *Recall:* say 以后我想当医生 — *yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng dāng yīshēng* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 我最喜欢中国菜 — *wǒ zuì xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *jiù*, old — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 马上 — *mǎshàng*, at once — **R3**

You'll want to know: 就

就 — *jiù* — "then; right away".

我马上就来 *wǒ mǎshàng jiù lái* — I'll be right there.

吃了饭 我就去 *chī le fàn, wǒ jiù qù* — Once I've eaten, I'll go.

It sounds like *jiù*, old, which you know: the same sound, a different word. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

就 (*jiù*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to accomplish', 'to go to meet' and 'to approach'. 'Then; right away' is not given there, so how the word came by it is not settled.

What you've built

就 sits after the person, right before the verb: 我马上就来. It ties what comes next to what came first: 吃了饭, 我就去.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiù*
- *Say it: jiù*, once more
- *Say it:* 我马上就来 — *wǒ mǎshàng jiù lái* — I'll be right there.
- *Say it:* 吃了饭 我就去 — *chī le fàn, wǒ jiù qù* — Once I've eaten, I'll go.
- *Recall:* say *jiù*, old, then 就, then: the same sound, two words

Before you move on

What does 就 mean? ("Then; right away".) Where does it go? (**After the person, right before the verb**.)

288.2 就 — a dot, a bar, 口 and 小, then a four-stroke right side

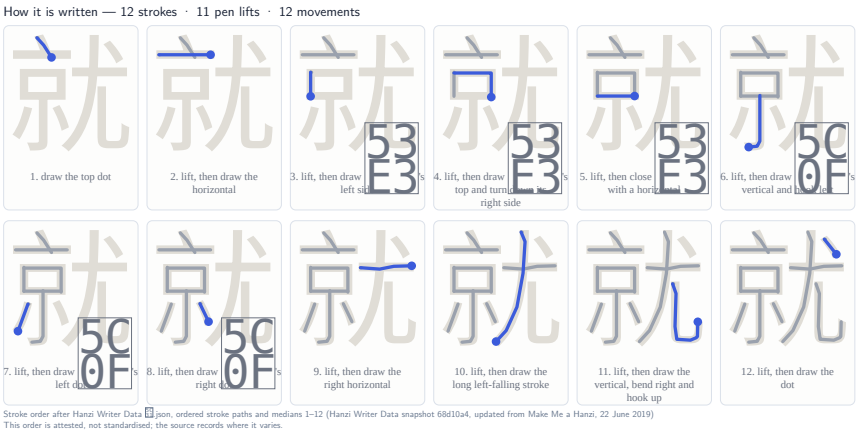
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  文 口 小

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wén*, *kǒu*, *xiǎo*

Script — a dot, a bar, 口 and 小, then a four-stroke right side



How 就 *is written, stroke by stroke*

就

Four pieces: three you write, and one new one on the right.
A dot and a horizontal, as 文 opens.
口, three strokes, under them.
小, three strokes, under 口: the hooked vertical, then the left dot, then the right dot.
The right side, four strokes: a horizontal; a long left-falling stroke; a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up; and last the dot at the upper right.
2 + 3 + 3 + 4 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 就, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 就? (**Twelve.**) Which character you write opens the same way? (**文: a dot and a horizontal.**) Which stroke

comes last? (**The dot at the upper right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 就, pinned stroke paths and medians.

288.3 要是 (yàoshi) — if

Before the new one: the character you wrote last, and a word that sounds the same as this one.

- *Read it:* 我马上就来, aloud — *wǒ mǎshàng jiù lái*
- *Recall:* say *yàoshi*, a key — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 要是

要是 — *yàoshi* — "if".

> 要是明天下雨 我就不去了 *yàoshi míngtiān xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le* — If it rains tomorrow, I won't go.

It sounds like *yàoshi*, a key: the same sound, a different word. Every character in it is one you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

要是 (*yàoshi*) is built from 要 and 是, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jiewH* and *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to bind by agreement' and 'right, as against wrong'. 'If' for the pair is the modern word's own sense.

What you've built

要是 opens the condition; 就 opens what follows, after its subject: 我就不去了 *wǒ jiù bú qù le*.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàoshi*
- *Say it: yàoshi*, once more
- *Say it:* 要是明天下雨 我就不去了 — *yàoshi míngtiān xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le* — If it rains tomorrow, I won't go.

- *Recall:* say *yàoshi*, a key, then 要是, if

Before you move on

What does 要是 mean? ("If".) Which word that sounds the same do you know? (*yàoshi*, a key.)

288.4 要是...就... — if, then

Two words from this chapter, made into one frame.

- *Read it:* 要是, aloud — *yàoshi*
- *Recall:* say 我马上就来 — *wǒ mǎshàng jiù lái* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 下雨 — *xiàyǔ*, to rain — **R3**, durable

Grammar Lens: 要是 ... 就 ..., if and then

要是 opens what might happen; 就 opens what follows if it does.

要是明天下雨 我就不去了 *yàoshi míngtiān xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le* — If it rains tomorrow, I won't go. 要是你病了 就回家 *yàoshi nǐ bìng le, jiù huí jiā* — If you're ill, go home.

就 goes after the subject of the second clause, right before its verb: 我就不去了. With no subject there, 就 opens the clause: 就回家.
了 at the end of 我就不去了 says the plan has changed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 要是明天下雨 我就不去了 — *yàoshi míngtiān xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le* — If it rains tomorrow, I won't go.
- 要是你病了 就回家 — *yàoshi nǐ bìng le, jiù huí jiā* — If you're ill, go home.
- what you will do tomorrow if it is cold, with 要是 … 就 …

Before you move on

Which word opens the condition? (要是.) Where does 就 go? (**After the subject of the second clause, right before its verb**.)

288.5 的话 (dehuà) — if, at the end

Before the new one: last lesson's frame, and a word you have had since the early chapters.

- *Read it:* 要是你病了 就回家, aloud — *yàoshi nǐ bìng le, jiù huí jiā*
- *Recall:* say 话 — *huà*, words — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 的话

的话 — *dehuà* — "if", closing a condition from behind.

下雨的话 我们就不去了 *xiàyǔ dehuà, wǒmen jiù bú qù le* — If it rains, we won't go.

要是你有时间的话 就来我家 *yàoshi nǐ yǒu shíjiān dehuà, jiù lái wǒ jiā* — If you've got time, come round.

Both characters are ones you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

的话 (*dehuà*) is built from 的 and 话 'words'. 话 is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'speech'; the particle 的 is the one whose history is not settled. 'If' for the pair is the modern word's own sense, and its first syllable is light.

What you've built

要是 opens the condition from the front; 的话 closes it from behind. Use either, or both: 要是你有时间的话.

Your turn

- *Say it: dehuà*
- *Say it: dehuà*, once more
- *Say it:* 下雨的话 我们就不去了 — *xiàyǔ dehuà, wǒmen jiù bú qù le* — If it rains, we won't go.
- *Say it:* 要是你有时间的话 就来我家 — *yàoshi nǐ yǒu shíjiān dehuà, jiù lái wǒ jiā* — If you've got time, come round.
- *Recall:* say 要是, then 的话: the front of a condition, then its back

Before you move on

What does 的话 mean? ("If".) Where does it go? (**At the end of the condition**.)

288.6 看天气 — it depends on the weather

A verb you have used since the first chapters, doing a new job.

- *Recall:* say 的话 — *dehuà*, if — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 看 — *kàn*, to look — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 天气 — *tiānqì*, the weather — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 看 and a noun, it depends on

看 and a noun can say 'it depends on': what happens turns on that.

去不去 要看天气 *qù bu qù, yào kàn tiānqì* — Whether we go depends on the weather. 那要看你 *nà yào kàn nǐ* — That's up to you.

去不去, go or not, is the open question; 要看 and the noun says what settles it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 去不去 要看天气 — *qù bu qù, yào kàn tiānqì* — Whether we go depends on the weather.
- 那要看你 — *nà yào kàn nǐ* — That's up to you.
- what your weekend depends on, with 要看

Before you move on

What does 要看天气 say? (**It depends on the weather**.) And 那要看你? (**That's up to you**.)

288.7 要是下雨 我就不去了

The chapter closes here, with a plan that hangs on the weather.

- *Read it:* 去不去 要看天气, aloud — *qù bu qù, yào kàn tiānqì*
- *Recall:* say 的话 — *dehuà* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 要是 — *yàoshi*, if — **R2**

The exchange

A: 明天你去山上吗

míngtiān nǐ qù shān shàng ma — Are you going up the mountain tomorrow?

B: 要看天气

yào kàn tiānqì — It depends on the weather.

A: *tiānqì yùbào shuō kěnéng huì xiàyǔ* — The forecast says it might rain.

B: 要是下雨 我就不去了

yàoshi xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le — If it rains, I won't go.

A: 不下雨的话呢

bú xiàyǔ dehuà ne — And if it doesn't?

B: 不下雨的话 我就去

bú xiàyǔ dehuà, wǒ jiù qù — If it doesn't, I'll go.

A: 要是你有时间的话 就来我家

yàoshi nǐ yǒu shíjiān dehuà, jiù lái wǒ jiā — If you've got time, come round.

B: 好 我马上就来

hǎo, wǒ mǎshàng jiù lái — All right, I'll be right over.

要是 opens one condition, 的话 closes the next, and 就 opens each result. 要看天气 answers the question before it is settled.

Read this

Read it: the exchange through once without stopping, then answer the question below

What you've built — if, and what it depends on

Three ways to put a condition, and one to say it is not settled:

- 要是下雨 我就不去了 *yàoshi xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le* — 要是 at the front.
- 下雨的话 我们就不去了 *xiàyǔ dehuà, wǒmen jiù bú qù le* — 的话 at the back.
- 要是你有时间的话 *yàoshi nǐ yǒu shíjiān dehuà* — both.
- 要看天气 *yào kàn tiānqì* — it depends.

Listen. *Yàoshi míngtiān hěn lěng, nǐ qù ma?*
Speak. Say two things you will do this weekend, each depending on something.
Write it: 就 — the opening of 文, 口 and 小, then the right side

Your turn

- *Say it:* 要是你有时间的话 就来我家 — *yàoshi nǐ yǒu shíjiān dehuà, jiù lái wǒ jiā* — If you've got time, come round.
- *Say it:* 去不去 要看天气 — *qù bu qù, yào kàn tiānqì* — Whether we go depends on the weather.
- *Say it:* the whole exchange, both parts
- *Write it:* 要是下雨 我就不去了

Before you move on

Say if it rains, you won't go. (要是下雨 我就不去了.) Say it depends on the weather. (要看天气.) Say you'll be right there. (我马上就来.)

Chapter 289

If I Had the Time

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what I would do if things were different, and write six connected lines.

Complete ZH-R289-review-final-289: one dialogue across the B1 core, after saying what would happen with 如果 … 就会 *…, otherwise with* 不然*, and writing six connected lines to a friend about a trip that went wrong.*

289.1 如果 (rúguǒ) — if

A new chapter, and it opens on an if that fits anywhere, in speech or in writing.

- *Recall:* say 要是下雨 我就不去了 — *yàoshi xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le* — **R1**, the chapter you have finished
- *Recall:* say 要是 — *yàoshi*, if — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *jiéguǒ*, as a result — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 如果

如果 — *rúguǒ* — "if; in case".

如果你有时间 就来我家 *rúguǒ nǐ yǒu shíjiān, jiù lái wǒ jiā* — If you have time, come round.

如果 means what 要是 means, and it fits anywhere, in speech or in writing; 要是 sounds more casual. The next lesson puts the second character in your hand; the first is the 如 of 比如, and the second is the guǒ of *jiéguǒ*.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

如果 (*rúguǒ*) is built from 如 and 果, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyo* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first with several words, among them 'to resemble', and the second 'resolute' and 'the fruit of a tree'. Whether 'if' was already among the first's senses the gloss does not make clear; 'if' for the pair is the modern word's sense.

What you've built

如果 opens the condition as 要是 does, and 就 opens the result. 要是 belongs to easy talk; 如果 fits a chat, a note or a talk alike.

Your turn

- *Say it: rúguǒ*
- *Say it: rúguǒ*, once more
- *Say it:* 如果你有时间 就来我家 — *rúguǒ nǐ yǒu shíjiān, jiù lái wǒ jiā* — If you have time, come round.
- *Recall:* say 要是, then 如果: the casual if, then the one that fits anywhere

Before you move on

What does 如果 mean? ("If".) Which word means the same, more casually? (要是.)

289.2 果 — 日, with 木 running through it

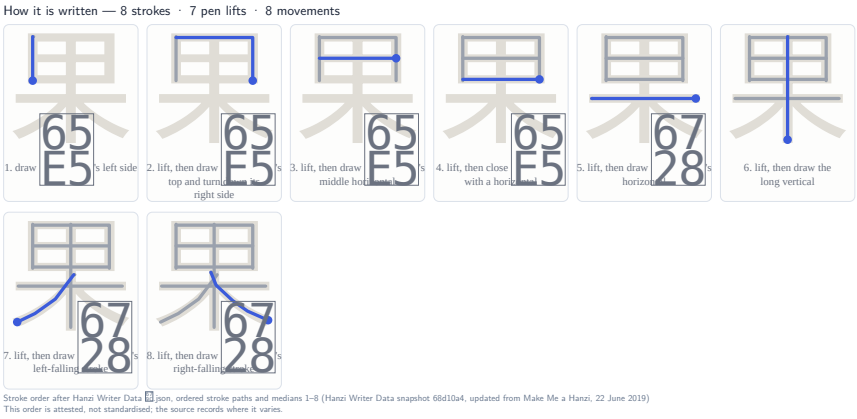
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *rúguǒ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

日 本

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *běn*

Script — 日, with 木 running through it



How 果 *is written, stroke by stroke*

果

Two pieces, and you write both already, one woven through the other.

日**, four strokes**, on top: the left side, the top that turns down the right side, the middle bar, the bottom bar. It is closed before anything else.

木**, four strokes**, as in 本: the long horizontal under 日; then the vertical, which starts at the top of 日 and runs down through it to the foot; then the left-falling stroke and the right-falling stroke.

4 + 4 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 果, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 果? (**Eight.**) Which stroke runs through 日? (**The vertical of 木, the sixth.**) What is closed first? (日.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 果, pinned stroke paths and medians.

289.3 如果...就... — if, then

Last chapter's frame, with this chapter's word at its front.

- *Read it:* 如果, aloud — *rúguǒ*
- *Recall:* say 要是你病了 就回家 — *yàoshi nǐ bìng le, jiù huí jiā* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say 的话 — *dehuà* — **R2**

Grammar Lens: 如果 ... 就 ..., if and then

如果 opens the condition and 就 opens the result, as 要是 ... 就 ... does, in speech or in writing.

如果明天不下雨 我们就去山上 *rúguǒ míngtiān bú xiàyǔ, wǒmen jiù qù shān shàng* — If it doesn't rain tomorrow, we'll go up the mountain. 如果你有时间的话 就来我家 *rúguǒ nǐ yǒu shíjiān dehuà, jiù lái wǒ jiā* — If you have the time, come round.

就 sits where it sat after 要是: after the subject, before the verb. 的话 can close the condition here too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 如果明天不下雨 我们就去山上 — *rúguǒ míngtiān bú xiàyǔ, wǒmen jiù qù shān shàng* — If it doesn't rain tomorrow, we'll go up the mountain.
- 如果你有时间的话 就来我家 — *rúguǒ nǐ yǒu shíjiān dehuà, jiù lái wǒ jiā* — If you have the time, come round.
- one plan for next week, with 如果 … 就 …

Before you move on

Which word opens the result after 如果? (就.) Where does it go? (**After the subject, before the verb**.)

289.4 如果...就会... — what would happen

A word from the A2 chapters on the future, after 就.

- *Read it:* 如果明天不下雨 我们就去山上, aloud — *rúguǒ míngtiān bú xiàyǔ, wǒmen jiù qù shān shàng*
- *Recall:* say 明天会下雨 — *míngtiān huì xiàyǔ* — **R3**, durable
- *Recall:* say 有钱 — *yǒuqián*, rich — **R3**

Grammar Lens: 如果 ... 就会 ..., a result you picture

会 after 就 says what would happen: 如果 ... 就会 ... for a result you picture.

如果我有钱 我就会去中国 *rúguǒ wǒ yǒu qián, wǒ jiù huì qù Zhōngguó* — If I had the money, I would go to China. 如果我有时间 我就会学开车 *rúguǒ wǒ yǒu shíjiān, wǒ jiù huì xué kāichē* — If I had the time, I would learn to drive.

There is no new form here. It is the 会 of 明天会下雨, a forecast, now forecasting a result you picture.
Nothing in the verb says whether the condition is real: 如果我有钱 can be if I have the money, or if I had it. The rest of the conversation tells you.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- 如果我有钱 我就会去中国 — *rúguǒ wǒ yǒu qián, wǒ jiù huì qù Zhōngguó* — If I had the money, I would go to China.
- 如果我有时间 我就会学开车 — *rúguǒ wǒ yǒu shíjiān, wǒ jiù huì xué kāichē* — If I had the time, I would learn to drive.

- what you would do if you had a free year, with 如果 … 就会 …

Before you move on

What does 会 add after 就? (**What would happen**.) Is it a new form? (**No: the 会 of a forecast**.)

289.5 不然 (bùrán) — otherwise

Before the new one: last lesson's picture, and a word for hurrying.

- *Read it:* 如果我有钱 我就会去中国, aloud — *rúguǒ wǒ yǒu qián, wǒ jiù huì qù Zhōngguó*
- *Recall:* say 快 — *kuài*, quick — **R3**, durable

You'll want to know: 不然

不然 — *bùrán* — "otherwise; or else".

快点儿 不然我们就晚了 *kuài diǎnr, bùrán wǒmen jiù wǎn le* — Hurry up, or we'll be late.

你得早点儿走 不然就晚了 *nǐ děi zǎo diǎnr zǒu, bùrán jiù wǎn le* — You have to leave early, or you'll be late.

不 before the rising rán stays *bù*. Every character in it is one you write.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不然 (*bùrán*) is built from 不 'not' and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese. The Guangyun lists 不 under three readings, *pjuw*, *pjuwX* and *pjut*, all glossed 'not'. bù comes from *pjut* irregularly: other syllables of its kind changed their p to f, while 不 kept the plain lip sound, now written b. 然 is *nyen*, glossed 'so, like this' (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). 'Not so', and so 'otherwise', is the plain sum of the two.

What you've built

不然 comes after the advice and says what happens if it is not taken. 就 often opens that result: 不然我们就晚了.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùrán*
- *Say it: bùrán*, once more
- *Say it:* 快点儿 不然我们就晚了 — *kuài diǎnr, bùrán wǒmen jiù wǎn le* — Hurry up, or we'll be late.
- *Say it:* 你得早点儿走 不然就晚了 — *nǐ děi zǎo diǎnr zǒu, bùrán jiù wǎn le* — You have to leave early, or you'll be late.
- *Recall:* say 然后, then 不然: the same 然, two words

Before you move on

What does 不然 mean? ("Otherwise".) Where does it go? (**After the advice, before what happens if it is not taken**.)

289.6 Six lines to a friend, a story with advice at the end

A trip of yours went wrong: a train missed, a bag lost, rain where there should have been sun. A friend is about to make the same trip.

This lesson tells them what happened, and what to do.

- *Recall:* say 不然 — *bùrán*, otherwise — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say 如果 … 就会 … — *rúguǒ … jiù huì …* — **R2**

What to know first

Six connected lines are not six sentences in a row: each leans on the one before, and the reader does not have to ask what happened next.

You own what does the leaning. **Order words**: 先, 然后, 突然, 最后. **The time at the front**: 那天, 第二天, 的时候. **The subject said once**: 我 in the first line, then the order word or the time. 因为 **...** 所以 **...** gives the reason; 如果 **...** 就 **...** or 应该 turns the story into advice.

Your reader is the friend. Your purpose is to save them the same trouble.

Writing — connected composition

Write **six lines** to your friend. Here is a frame for each; the words are yours, and there is no model to copy.

- Line 1: when and where, and what you did first, with 先 and 了.
- Line 2: what came next, with 然后.
- Line 3: what went wrong, with 突然, or with 的时候 and 正在.
- Line 4: how it ended, with 最后, or what you had never done before, with 过.
- Line 5: the reason it went wrong, with 因为 … 所以 ….
- Line 6: your advice, with 如果 … 就 … or 应该.

A word whose characters you have not written goes in pinyin, inside the line, with its tone marks. Every character comes from the 227 you have learned, each in the order you learned it, each in the same size of square.

No Chinese commas or full stops: leave a space between clauses, as this book prints them.

Write the six lines. Then read them once as your friend would, top to bottom: would they know what to do?

Before you move on

Cover lines 1 and 2, and read line 3. Does it lean on them? (**It should: 突然 breaks into what was going on**.)
Which line could your friend act on tomorrow? (**Line 6, the advice**.)

289.7 The B1 core — once more

The last lesson of the B1 core: one conversation across all of it.

- *Recall:* say *duōjiǔ*, how long — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *yíhàn*, a pity — **R3**
- *Recall:* say 不然 — *bùrán*, otherwise — **R2**

Your turn

A: 那天你做什么了

nà tiān nǐ zuò shénme le — What did you do that day?

B: 我先去了书店 然后坐火车回家

wǒ xiān qù le shūdiàn, ránhòu zuò huǒchē huí jiā — First the bookshop, then home by train.

B: 在火车上 我的手机突然不见了

zài huǒchē shàng, wǒ de shǒujī tūrán bú jiàn le — On the train my phone suddenly went missing.

A: 你找回了吗

nǐ zhǎohuí le ma — Did you get it back?

B: 最后找回了 我感觉很好

zuìhòu zhǎohuí le, wǒ gǎnjué hěn hǎo — In the end I did. I feel fine.

B: *wǒ de zhèngjiàn yě bú jiàn le, wǒ děi mǎshàng guàshī* — My papers are gone too; I must report them lost at once.

A: *wǒ juéde nǐ yīnggāi xiān liánxì wǒ* — I think you should have got in touch with me first.

B: *yīnwèi wǒ hěn lèi, suǒyǐ wàng le* — I was tired, so I forgot.

A: 以后你想当什么

yǐhòu nǐ xiǎng dāng shénme — What do you want to be later on?

B: *wǒ de mèngxiǎng shì dāng yīshēng, wǒ de mùbiāo shì shuō hǎo Hànyǔ* — My dream is to be a doctor; my goal is to speak good Chinese.

A: *nǐ xué le duōjiǔ* — How long have you studied?

B: *liǎng nián, wǒ méi qù guo Zhōngguó, tài yíhàn le* — Two years. I've never been to China, sadly.

A: 明天去山上吗 去山上怎么走

míngtiān qù shān shàng ma, qù shān shàng zěnme zǒu — Going up the mountain tomorrow? How do you get there?

B: 要看天气 要是下雨的话 我就不去了

yào kàn tiānqì, yàoshi xiàyǔ dehuà, wǒ jiù bú qù le — It depends on the weather. If it rains, I won't go.

A: 如果不下雨 我们就坐火车去

rúguǒ bú xiàyǔ, wǒmen jiù zuò huǒchē qù — If it doesn't rain, we'll go by train.

B: 那早点儿走 不然就晚了

nà zǎo diǎnr zǒu, bùrán jiù wǎn le — Then let's leave early, or we'll be late.

- *Read it:* the lines printed in characters aloud, then the rest
- *Say it:* the whole dialogue, both parts
- *Say it:* B's lines, with your own answers

Before you move on

First, then, last? (**先, 然后, 最后**.) Should? (**应该**.) Gone missing? (**不见了**.) How long? (*duōjiǔ*.) If, then? (**要是 ... 就 ..., 如果 ... 就**

....) Would? (就会.) Otherwise? (不然.)

Chapter 290

In the News

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the news, the radio, the host of a show and what everyone is talking about.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 290: I can talk about the news, the radio, the host of a show and what everyone is talking about.*

290.1 xīnwén — the news; news on TV and radio

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for if, then the Mandarin for otherwise.

You'll want to know: xīnwén

xīnwén — "the news; news on TV and radio".

> *wǒ měitiān tīng xīnwén* — I listen to the news every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnwén is built from *xīn* 'new' and *wén* 'to hear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *mjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'new, as against old' and the second 'to know by its sound': what is newly heard.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnwén*
- *Say it: xīnwén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān tīng xīnwén* — I listen to the news every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for if, then the Mandarin for otherwise, then say *xīnwén* again

Before you move on

What does xīnwén mean? ("The news; news on TV and radio".) Say it once more.

290.2 bàodào — to report on; a news report

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for otherwise, then the Mandarin for the news on TV.

You'll want to know: bàodào

bàodào — "to report on; a news report".

diànshì bàodào le zhège xiāoxi — The news was reported on TV.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàodào is built from *bào* 'to report' and *dào*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawH* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to report' and the second 'a road' and 'a principle'; its sense 'to say' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàodào*
- *Say it: bàodào*, once more
- *Say it: diànshì bàodào le zhège xiāoxi* — The news was reported on TV.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for otherwise, then the Mandarin for the news on TV, then say *bàodào* again

Before you move on

What does bàodào mean? ("To report on; a news report".) Say it once more.

290.3 diàntái — radio station

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the news on TV, then the Mandarin for to report on the news.

You'll want to know: diàntái

diàntái — "radio station".

wǒ bàba zài diàntái gōngzuò guo — My dad once worked at a radio station.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diàntái is built from 电 'electricity' and *tái* 'a platform', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *doj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as lightning and the second 'a high, square mound of earth'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: diàntái*
- *Say it: diàntái*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba zài diàntái gōngzuò guo* — My dad once worked at a radio station.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the news on TV, then the Mandarin for to report on the news, then say *diàntái* again

Before you move on

What does diàntái mean? ("Radio station".) Say it once more.

290.4 zhǔchírén — presenter; host of a show

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to report on the news, then the Mandarin for a radio station.

You'll want to know: zhǔchírén

zhǔchírén — "presenter; host of a show".

zhège jiémù de zhǔchírén hěn yǒuyìsi — The host of this show is a lot of fun.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔchírén is built from *zhǔ* 'to be in charge', *chí* 'to hold' and 人 'a person', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuX*, *dri* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be in charge of' and the second 'to hold': the person who holds the show together.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔchírén*
- *Say it: zhǔchírén*, once more
- *Say it: zhège jiémù de zhǔchírén hěn yǒuyìsi* — The host of this show is a lot of fun.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to report on the news, then the Mandarin for a radio station, then say *zhǔchírén* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔchírén mean? ("Presenter; host of a show".) Say it once more.

290.5 热点 (rèdiǎn) — hot topic; what everyone is talking about

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a radio station, then the Mandarin for the presenter of a show.

You'll want to know: 热点

热点 — *rèdiǎn* — "hot topic; what everyone is talking about".

这是今天的热点 *zhè shì jīntiān de rèdiǎn* — This is today's hot topic.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

热点 (*rèdiǎn*) is built from 热 'hot' and 点 'a dot', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyet* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'burning, as by fire' and the second 'a dot or stroke': a hot spot, the story everyone is talking about.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: rèdiǎn*
- *Say it: rèdiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì jīntiān de rèdiǎn* — This is today's hot topic.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a radio station, then the Mandarin for the presenter of a show, then say *rèdiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 热点 mean? ("Hot topic; what everyone is talking about".) Say it once more.

Chapter 291

Something New

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone was interviewed, something was invented, an event broke out and news was announced.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 291: I can say someone was interviewed, something was invented, an event broke out and news was announced.*

291.1 cǎifǎng — to interview someone for the news

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the presenter of a show, then the Mandarin for what everyone is talking about.

You'll want to know: cǎifǎng

cǎifǎng — "to interview someone for the news".

> *jìzhě cǎifǎng le wǒmen* — A reporter interviewed us.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: cǎi is said with a rising tone before fǎng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cǎifǎng is built from *cǎi* 'to pick' and *fǎng* 'to ask about', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshojX* and *phjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to take' and the second 'to consult': to gather news by asking. *phjangH* would regularly give fàng; the dipping tone of fǎng is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: cǎifǎng*
- *Say it: cǎifǎng*, once more
- *Say it: jìzhě cǎifǎng le wǒmen* — A reporter interviewed us.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the presenter of a show, then the Mandarin for what everyone is talking about, then say *cǎifǎng* again

Before you move on

What does cǎifǎng mean? ("To interview someone for the news".) Say it once more.

291.2 发明 (fāmíng) — to invent; an invention

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what everyone is talking about, then the Mandarin for to interview someone for the news.

You'll want to know: 发明

发明 — *fāmíng* — "to invent; an invention".

他发明了一个小东西 *tā fāmíng le yí ge xiǎo dōngxi* — He invented a little gadget.

The new character, in pieces: 发 — five strokes in three small groups: a short stroke that drops and turns to the right, and a long sweep down to the left from the top; then a fork of two strokes crossing below; then a dot at the top right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

发明 (*fāmíng*) is built from 发 'to send out' and 明 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *mjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to start' and 'to make clear' and the second 'light' and 'clear': to bring something to light.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāmíng*
- *Say it: fāmíng*, once more
- *Say it: tā fāmíng le yí ge xiǎo dōngxi* — He invented a little gadget.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what everyone is talking about, then the Mandarin for to interview someone for the news, then say *fāmíng* again

Before you move on

What does 发明 mean? ("To invent; an invention".) Say it once more.

291.3 发 — a bent stroke, a sweep, a fork and a dot

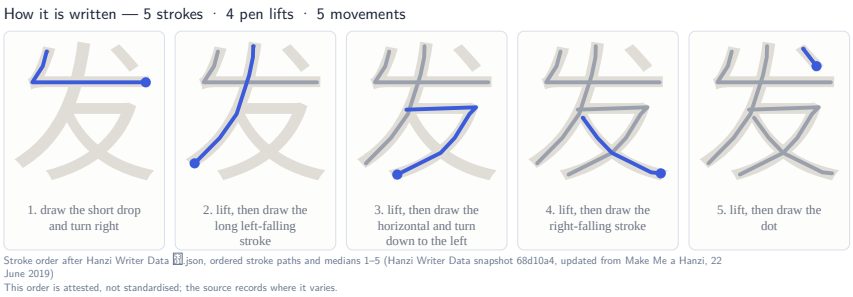
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *fāmíng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  突 明

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tū*, *míng*

Script — a bent stroke, a sweep, a fork and a dot



How 发 is written, stroke by stroke

发

One shape, three small groups. Count the groups, not the strokes.

The frame, two strokes. A short stroke that drops and turns to run across to the right, rising a little. Then a long sweep from the top middle, down to the lower left, crossing it.

The fork, two strokes. A bar that turns into a sweep down to the lower left. Then a long stroke falling to the right from under the bar, out to the foot.

The dot, one stroke, high on the right.

2 + 2 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 发, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 发? (**Five.**) Which stroke comes first? (**The short one that drops and turns right.**) What comes last? (**The dot, high on the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 发, pinned stroke paths and medians.

291.4 shìjiàn — incident; event (in the news)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to interview someone for the news, then the Mandarin for to invent something.

You'll want to know: shìjiàn

shìjiàn — "incident; event (in the news)".

zhège shìjiàn fāshēng zài Běijīng — The incident happened in Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shìjiàn is built from 事 'a matter' and *jiàn* 'an item', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzriH* and *gjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to divide into parts'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìjiàn*
- *Say it: shìjiàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège shìjiàn fāshēng zài Běijīng* — The incident happened in Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to interview someone for the news, then the Mandarin for to invent something, then say *shìjiàn* again

Before you move on

What does shìjiàn mean? ("Incident; event (in the news)".) Say it once more.

291.5 突发 (tūfā) — to break out suddenly; sudden

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to invent something, then the Mandarin for an incident in the news.

You'll want to know: 突发

突发 — *tūfā* — "to break out suddenly; sudden".

zhè shì yí ge tūfā shìjiàn — This is a sudden, unexpected event.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

突发 (*tūfā*) is built from 突 'to burst out' and 发 'to start', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwot* and *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the look of something coming out'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tūfā*
- *Say it: tūfā*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì yí ge tūfā shìjiàn* — This is a sudden, unexpected event.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to invent something, then the Mandarin for an incident in the news, then say *tūfā* again

Before you move on

What does 突发 mean? ("To break out suddenly; sudden".) Say it once more.

291.6 xuānbù — to announce officially

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an incident in the news, then the Mandarin for to break out suddenly.

You'll want to know: xuānbù

xuānbù — "to announce officially".

> *xuéxiào xuānbù míngtiān fàngjià* — The school announced a day off tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuānbù is built from *xuān* 'to make known' and *bù* 'to spread', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjwen* and *puH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to spread' and 'to make clear' and the second 'to spread everywhere'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuānbù*
- *Say it: xuānbù*, once more
- *Say it: xuéxiào xuānbù míngtiān fàngjià* — The school announced a day off tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an incident in the news, then the Mandarin for to break out suddenly, then say *xuānbù* again

Before you move on

What does xuānbù mean? ("To announce officially".) Say it once more.

Chapter 292

On the Radio

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about broadcasts and live shows, viewers and listeners, and what someone published.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 292: I can talk about broadcasts and live shows, viewers and listeners, and what someone published.*

292.1 guǎngbō — to broadcast; a broadcast

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to break out suddenly, then the Mandarin for to announce officially.

You'll want to know: guǎngbō

guǎngbō — "to broadcast; a broadcast".

> *diàntái měitiān zǎoshang guǎngbō xīnwén* — The station broadcasts the news every morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǎngbō is built from *guǎng* 'wide' and *bō* 'to scatter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwangX* and *paH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'big' and 'broad' and the second 'to spread' and 'to sow': to spread far and wide. The level tone of bō is irregular for *paH*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǎngbō*
- *Say it: guǎngbō*, once more
- *Say it: diàntái měitiān zǎoshang guǎngbō xīnwén* — The station broadcasts the news every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to break out suddenly, then the Mandarin for to announce officially, then say *guǎngbō* again

Before you move on

What does guǎngbō mean? ("To broadcast; a broadcast".) Say it once more.

292.2 guānzhòng — viewers; spectators; the people watching a show

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to announce officially, then the Mandarin for to broadcast on the radio.

You'll want to know: guānzhòng

guānzhòng — "viewers; spectators; the people watching a show".

guānzhòng dōu hěn xǐhuan zhège jiémù — The viewers all love this show.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guānzhòng is built from *guān* 'to watch' and *zhòng* 'a crowd', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwan* and *tsyuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to view' and the second 'many', adding that three people make a crowd.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānzhòng*
- *Say it: guānzhòng*, once more
- *Say it: guānzhòng dōu hěn xǐhuan zhège jiémù* — The viewers all love this show.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to announce officially, then the Mandarin for to broadcast on the radio, then say *guānzhòng* again

Before you move on

What does guānzhòng mean? ("Viewers; spectators; the people watching a show".) Say it once more.

292.3 zhíbō — to broadcast live; a live show

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to broadcast on the radio, then the Mandarin for the people watching a show.

You'll want to know: zhíbō

zhíbō — "to broadcast live; a live show".

diànshì zhèngzài zhíbō zúqiú bǐsài — The football match is on live on TV right now.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhíbō is built from *zhí* 'straight' and *bō* 'to scatter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drik* and *paH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'upright' and 'straight'. The level tone of bō is irregular for *paH*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíbō*
- *Say it: zhíbō*, once more
- *Say it: diànshì zhèngzài zhíbō zúqiú bǐsài* — The football match is on live on TV right now.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to broadcast on the radio, then the Mandarin for the people watching a show, then say *zhíbō* again

Before you move on

What does zhíbō mean? ("To broadcast live; a live show".) Say it once more.

292.4 tīngzhòng — listeners; the people listening to the radio

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the people watching a show, then the Mandarin for to broadcast live.

You'll want to know: tīngzhòng

tīngzhòng — "listeners; the people listening to the radio".

rúguǒ yǒu tīngzhòng dǎ diànhuà, zhǔchírén jiù huì huídá — If a listener calls in, the host will answer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tīngzhòng is built from *tīng* 'to listen' and *zhòng* 'a crowd', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *theng* and *tsyuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to listen' and the second 'many'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīngzhòng*
- *Say it: tīngzhòng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ yǒu tīngzhòng dǎ diànhuà, zhǔchírén jiù huì huídá* — If a listener calls in, the host will answer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the people watching a show, then the Mandarin for to broadcast live, then say *tīngzhòng* again

Before you move on

What does tīngzhòng mean? ("Listeners; the people listening to the radio".) Say it once more.

292.5 fābiǎo — to publish an article; to make public

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to broadcast live, then the Mandarin for the people listening to the radio.

You'll want to know: fābiǎo

fābiǎo — "to publish an article; to make public".

tā fābiǎo le yì piān xiǎoshuō — He published a short story.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fābiǎo is built from 发 'to send out' and *biǎo* 'the outside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *pjewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to make clear' and 'a letter to the throne': to send out where all can see.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fābiǎo*
- *Say it: fābiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: tā fābiǎo le yì piān xiǎoshuō* — He published a short story.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to broadcast live, then the Mandarin for the people listening to the radio, then say *fābiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does fābiǎo mean? ("To publish an article; to make public".) Say it once more.

Chapter 293

Headlines

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about newspapers and magazines, the lead story and the news I follow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 293: I can talk about newspapers and magazines, the lead story and the news I follow.*

293.1 zázhì — magazine

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the people listening to the radio, then the Mandarin for to publish an article.

You'll want to know: zázhì

zázhì — "magazine".

> *wǒ mǎi le liǎng běn zázhì* — I bought two magazines.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zázhì is built from *zá* 'mixed' and *zhì* 'a record', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzop* and *tsyiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to gather' and 'five colours together' and the second 'to note down': a record of many things.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zázhì*
- *Say it: zázhì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎi le liǎng běn zázhì* — I bought two magazines.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the people listening to the radio, then the Mandarin for to publish an article, then say *zázhì* again

Before you move on

What does zázhì mean? ("Magazine".) Say it once more.

293.2 报 (bào) — newspaper; the daily paper

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to publish an article, then the Mandarin for a magazine.

You'll want to know: 报

报 — *bào* — "newspaper; the daily paper".

我每天早上看报 *wǒ měitiān zǎoshang kàn bào* — I read the paper every morning.

The new character, in pieces: 报 — seven strokes in two pieces: on the left the hand piece of 打, three strokes; on the right a bar that turns down and hooks back, a long vertical down its left side, then a bar that turns into a sweep to the lower left and a long stroke falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

报 (*bào*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *pawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to report'; the sense 'a newspaper', the sheet that reports, is later and is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bào*
- *Say it: bào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān zǎoshang kàn bào* — I read the paper every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to publish an article, then the Mandarin for a magazine, then say *bào* again

Before you move on

What does 报 mean? ("Newspaper; the daily paper".) Say it once more.

293.3 报 — the hand piece, then a hook, a post and a fork

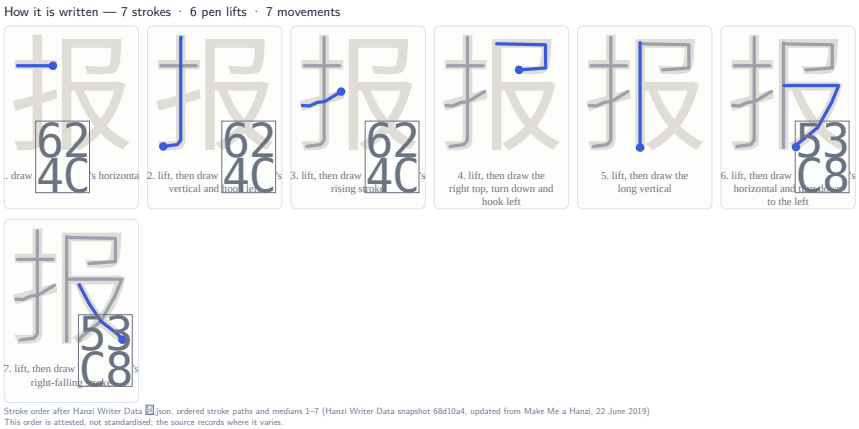
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  打 找

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dǎ*, *zhǎo*

Script — the hand piece, then a hook, a post and a fork



How 报 *is written, stroke by stroke*

报

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes. The hand piece of 打: a bar, a vertical that hooks to the left at the foot, and a stroke rising to the right across it.

The right piece, four strokes. A bar that turns down and hooks back to the left. A long vertical down the left side of the piece. Then the fork: a bar that turns into a sweep down to the lower left, and a long stroke falling to the right.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 报, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 报? (**Two.**) What is the left piece? (**The hand piece of 打, three strokes.**) What closes the right piece? (**A fork: a sweep to the left, then a long stroke to the right.**) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 报, pinned stroke paths and medians.

293.4 见报 (jiànbào) — to appear in the papers; to make the papers

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a magazine, then the Mandarin for the daily paper.

You'll want to know: 见报

见报 — *jiànbào* — "to appear in the papers; to make the papers".

我们学校见报了 *wǒmen xuéxiào jiànbào le* — Our school was in the paper.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

见报 (*jiànbào*) is built from 见 'to see' and 报 'a newspaper', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kenH* and *pawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to view': to be seen in the paper.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànbào*
- *Say it: jiànbào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xuéxiào jiànbào le* — Our school was in the paper.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a magazine, then the Mandarin for the daily paper, then say *jiànbào* again

Before you move on

What does 见报 mean? ("To appear in the papers; to make the papers".) Say it once more.

293.5 tóutiáo — lead story; headline; the front-page story

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the daily paper, then the Mandarin for to make the papers.

You'll want to know: tóutiáo

tóutiáo — "lead story; headline; the front-page story".

jīntiān de tóutiáo shì shénme — What's today's lead story?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóutiáo is built from 头 'the head' and *tiáo* 'a strip', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duw* and *dew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the head' and the second 'a small branch': the first strip, the story at the top.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóutiáo*
- *Say it: tóutiáo*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de tóutiáo shì shénme* — What's today's lead story?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the daily paper, then the Mandarin for to make the papers, then say *tóutiáo* again

Before you move on

What does tóutiáo mean? ("Lead story; headline; the front-page story".) Say it once more.

293.6 guānzhù — to follow a story closely; to keep an eye on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make the papers, then the Mandarin for the front-page story.

You'll want to know: guānzhù

guānzhù — "to follow a story closely; to keep an eye on".

rúguǒ nǐ guānzhù xīnwén, nǐ jiù huì zhīdào — If you followed the news, you'd know.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guānzhù is built from 关 'to shut' and *zhù* 'to pour', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaen* and *tsyuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the bar that holds a gate shut' and the second 'to pour into'; how the pair came to mean 'to follow closely' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānzhù*
- *Say it: guānzhù*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ guānzhù xīnwén, nǐ jiù huì zhīdào* — If you followed the news, you'd know.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make the papers, then the Mandarin for the front-page story, then say *guānzhù* again

Before you move on

What does guānzhù mean? ("To follow a story closely; to keep an eye on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 294

How It Turned Out

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how things stood, what caused something, what it changed and how it ended.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 294: I can say how things stood, what caused something, what it changed and how it ended.*

294.1 qíngkuàng — situation; how things stand

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the front-page story, then the Mandarin for to follow a story closely.

You'll want to know: qíngkuàng

qíngkuàng — "situation; how things stand".

> *nǐ děi gàosu wǒ qíngkuàng, bùrán wǒ huì dānxīn* — You have to tell me how things are, or I'll worry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qíngkuàng is built from *qíng* 'feeling' and *kuàng* 'to compare', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjeng* and *xjwangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'what a person desires' and the second 'to compare'; how the pair came to mean 'a situation' is not settled. *xjwangH* would regularly give huàng; the k of kuàng is

irregular.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qíngkuàng*
- *Say it: qíngkuàng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ děi gàosu wǒ qíngkuàng, bùrán wǒ huì dānxīn* — You have to tell me how things are, or I'll worry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the front-page story, then the Mandarin for to follow a story closely, then say *qíngkuàng* again

Before you move on

What does qíngkuàng mean? ("Situation; how things stand".) Say it once more.

294.2 yǐnqǐ — to give rise to; to bring about

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to follow a story closely, then the Mandarin for how things stand.

You'll want to know: yǐnqǐ

yǐnqǐ — "to give rise to; to bring about".

zhège xīnwén yǐnqǐ le dàjiā de zhùyì — The story caught everyone's attention.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: yǐn is said with a rising tone before qǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǐnqǐ is built from *yǐn* 'to draw (a bow)' and 起 'to rise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yinX* and *khiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'long' and 'to draw a bow' and the second 'to rise' and 'to start'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐnqǐ*
- *Say it: yǐnqǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xīnwén yǐnqǐ le dàjiā de zhùyì* — The story caught everyone's attention.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to follow a story closely, then the Mandarin for how things stand, then say *yǐnqǐ* again

Before you move on

What does yǐnqǐ mean? ("To give rise to; to bring about".) Say it once more.

294.3 yǐngxiǎng — to affect; influence; to have an effect on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how things stand, then the Mandarin for to give rise to something.

You'll want to know: yǐngxiǎng

yǐngxiǎng — "to affect; influence; to have an effect on".

xiàyǔ yǐngxiǎng le bǐsài — The rain affected the match.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: yǐng is said with a rising tone before xiǎng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǐngxiǎng is built from *yǐng* 'a shadow' and *xiǎng* 'a sound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jaengX* and *xjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a shape's shadow' and the second 'a sound'. It is usually explained as what follows a thing the way a shadow follows a shape and an echo a sound.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐngxiǎng*
- *Say it: yǐngxiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ yǐngxiǎng le bǐsài* — The rain affected the match.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how things stand, then the Mandarin for to give rise to something, then say *yǐngxiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does yǐngxiǎng mean? ("To affect; influence; to have an effect on".) Say it once more.

294.4 zhōngyú — at long last

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give rise to something, then the Mandarin for to have an effect on.

You'll want to know: zhōngyú

zhōngyú — "at long last".

děng le liǎng ge xiǎoshí, chē zhōngyú lái le — After a two-hour wait, the bus came at last.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhōngyú is built from *zhōng* 'the end' and *yú* 'at', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuwng* and *'jo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the end' and 'to use up' and the second 'to dwell' and calls it a particle; its sense 'at' is not given there. The rising tone of yú is irregular for *'jo*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōngyú*
- *Say it: zhōngyú*, once more
- *Say it: děng le liǎng ge xiǎoshí, chē zhōngyú lái le* — After a two-hour wait, the bus came at last.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give rise to something, then the Mandarin for to have an effect on, then say *zhōngyú* again

Before you move on

What does zhōngyú mean? ("At long last".) Say it once more.

294.5 yúshì — so; and then (as a result)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have an effect on, then the Mandarin for at long last.

You'll want to know: yúshì

yúshì — "so; and then (as a result)".

yǔ hěn dà, yúshì wǒmen huí jiā le — It was raining hard, so we went home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yúshì is built from *yú* 'at' and 是, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jo* and *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which calls the first a particle, without the sense 'at', and glosses the second 'right, not wrong'; how the pair came to mean 'and so' is not settled. The rising tone of yú is irregular for *'jo*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yúshì*
- *Say it: yúshì*, once more
- *Say it: yǔ hěn dà, yúshì wǒmen huí jiā le* — It was raining hard, so we went home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have an effect on, then the Mandarin for at long last, then say *yúshì* again

Before you move on

What does yúshì mean? ("So; and then (as a result)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 295

Starting Over

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how something was at first, that it began again, and that it happened that same day.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 295: I can say how something was at first, that it began again, and that it happened that same day.*

295.1 zuìchū — at the very start; initially

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at long last, then the Mandarin for and so it followed.

You'll want to know: zuìchū

zuìchū — "at the very start; initially".

> *zuìchū wǒ bù xǐhuan zhèr* — At first I didn't like it here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuìchū is built from 最 'most' and *chū* 'the start', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tswajH* and *tsrhjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the beginning': the very start.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuìchū*
- *Say it: zuìchū*, once more
- *Say it: zuìchū wǒ bù xǐhuan zhèr* — At first I didn't like it here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at long last, then the Mandarin for and so it followed, then say *zuìchū* again

Before you move on

What does zuìchū mean? ("At the very start; initially".) Say it once more.

295.2 重新 (chóngxīn) — anew; over again from the start

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for and so it followed, then the Mandarin for at the very start.

You'll want to know: 重新

重新 — *chóngxīn* — "anew; over again from the start".

你得重新写 *nǐ děi chóngxīn xiě* — You'll have to write it over again.

The new character, in pieces: 新 — thirteen strokes in three pieces: top left, the piece on the left of 站, five strokes; under it a bar, a vertical with a hook, a short sweep and a dot; on the right two strokes falling to the left, a bar and a long vertical. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

重新 (*chóngxīn*) is built from 重 'to repeat' and 新 'new', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjowng* and *sin* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, in this reading, 'to double' and 'to layer'; the same character read *drjowngX*, glossed 'much' and 'thick', is the source of zhòng 'heavy'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chóngxīn*
- *Say it: chóngxīn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ děi chóngxīn xiě* — You'll have to write it over again.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for and so it followed, then the Mandarin for at the very start, then say *chóngxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 重新 mean? ("Anew; over again from the start".) Say it once more.

295.3 新 — two pieces on the left, one on the right

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chóngxīn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  站 机

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhàn*, *jī*

Script — two pieces on the left, one on the right

How 新 *is written, stroke by stroke*

新

Three pieces: two stacked on the left, one on the right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

Top left, five strokes. The piece on the left of 站: a dot, a bar, a dot falling to the right and a short stroke falling to the left under it, then a bar across the foot.

Bottom left, four strokes. A bar, a vertical that hooks to the left at the foot, a short sweep to the lower left and a dot to the lower right: the tree piece of 机, with a hook.

The right piece, four strokes. A short sweep down to the left at the top. A long stroke down from under it that curves to the lower left. A bar across to the right. Then a long vertical down to the foot.

5 + 4 + 4 = thirteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 新, all thirteen, with the model in front of you

- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 新? (**Three**.) Where have you made the top left piece? (**On the left of 站**.) What is the last stroke? (**A long vertical on the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 新, pinned stroke paths and medians.

295.4 当天 (dàngtiān) — that same day; on that very day

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at the very start, then the Mandarin for over again from the start.

You'll want to know: 当天

当天 — *dàngtiān* — "that same day; on that very day".

他当天就回来了 *tā dàngtiān jiù huílái le* — He came back that same day.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当天 (*dàngtiān*) is built from 当 and 天 'a day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tangH* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, in this departing-tone reading, 'to be in charge'; how it came to mean 'that very (day)' is not settled. Read *tang*, the same character gives dāng.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàngtiān*
- *Say it: dàngtiān*, once more

- *Say it: tā dàngtiān jiù huílái le* — He came back that same day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at the very start, then the Mandarin for over again from the start, then say *dàngtiān* again

Before you move on

What does 当天 mean? ("That same day; on that very day".) Say it once more.

295.5 事后 (shìhòu) — after the event; in hindsight

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for over again from the start, then the Mandarin for on that very day.

You'll want to know: 事后

事后 — *shìhòu* — "after the event; in hindsight".

事后我们都笑了 *shìhòu wǒmen dōu xiào le* — Afterwards we all laughed.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

事后 (*shìhòu*) is built from 事 'a matter' and 后 'after', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzriH* and *huwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'first and after'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìhòu*
- *Say it: shìhòu*, once more
- *Say it: shìhòu wǒmen dōu xiào le* — Afterwards we all laughed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for over again from the start, then the Mandarin for on that very day, then say *shìhòu* again

Before you move on

What does 事后 mean? (“After the event; in hindsight”.) Say it once more.

295.6 dāngchǎng — on the spot; there and then

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for on that very day, then the Mandarin for after the event.

You’ll want to know: dāngchǎng

dāngchǎng — “on the spot; there and then”.

tā dāngchǎng jiù kū le — He burst into tears there and then.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dāngchǎng is built from 当 ’at’ and *chǎng* ’an open ground’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’to face’ and ’to meet’ and the second ’a place for offerings’ and ’a threshing floor’. Middle Chinese *drjang* would regularly give cháng; the dipping tone of chǎng is irregular.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngchǎng*
- *Say it: dāngchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: tā dāngchǎng jiù kū le* — He burst into tears there and then.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for on that very day, then the Mandarin for after the event, then say *dāngchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does dāngchǎng mean? ("On the spot; there and then".) Say it once more.

295.7 Looking back: from In the News to Starting Over

Say the Mandarin for the news on TV and to report on the news.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the news on TV, to report on the news, a radio station, the presenter of a show, what everyone is talking about
- *Say it:* to interview someone for the news, to invent something, an incident in the news, to break out suddenly, to announce officially
- *Say it:* to broadcast on the radio, the people watching a show, to broadcast live, the people listening to the radio, to publish an article
- *Say it:* a magazine, the daily paper, to make the papers, the front-page story, to follow a story closely
- *Say it:* how things stand, to give rise to something, to have an effect on, at long last, and so it followed
- *Say it:* at the very start, over again from the start, on that very day, after the event, right there on the spot
- *Read it:* 发 报 新 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The news on TV? (*xīnwén.*) To report on the news? (*bàodào.*) A radio station? (*diàntái.*) The presenter of a show? (*zhǔchírén.*) What everyone is talking about? (热点, *rèdiǎn.*) To interview someone for the news? (*cǎifǎng.*) To invent something? (发明, *fāmíng.*) An incident in the news? (*shìjiàn.*) To break out suddenly? (突发, *tūfā.*) To announce officially? (*xuānbù.*) To broadcast on the radio? (*guǎngbō.*) The people watching a show?

(*guānzhòng.*) To broadcast live? (*zhíbō.*) The people listening to the radio? (*tīngzhòng.*) To publish an article? (*fābiǎo.*) A magazine? (*zázhì.*) The daily paper? (报, *bào.*) To make the papers? (见报, *jiànbào.*) The front-page story? (*tóutiáo.*) To follow a story closely? (*guānzhù.*) How things stand? (*qíngkuàng.*) To give rise to something? (*yǐnqǐ.*) To have an effect on? (*yǐngxiǎng.*) At long last? (*zhōngyú.*) And so it followed? (*yúshì.*) At the very start? (*zuìchū.*) Over again from the start? (重新, *chóngxīn.*) On that very day? (当天, *dàngtiān.*) After the event? (事后, *shìhòu.*) Right there on the spot? (*dāngchǎng.*)

Chapter 296

A Crash

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a crash on the road: the brakes, a new driver and paying for the damage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 296: I can talk about a crash on the road: the brakes, a new driver and paying for the damage.*

296.1 意外 (yìwài) — mishap; something unexpected

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for after the event, then the Mandarin for right there on the spot.

You'll want to know: 意外

意外 — *yìwài* — "mishap; something unexpected".

> 意外发生的时候我在家 *yìwài fāshēng de shíhou, wǒ zài jiā* — When the accident happened, I was at home.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

意外 (*yìwài*) is built from 意 'an intention' and 外 'outside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ʔiH* and *ngwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'will' and the second 'outside' and 'far': outside what anyone intended.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìwài*
- *Say it: yìwài*, once more
- *Say it: yìwài fāshēng de shíhou, wǒ zài jiā* — When the accident happened, I was at home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for after the event, then the Mandarin for right there on the spot, then say *yìwài* again

Before you move on

What does 意外 mean? ("Mishap; something unexpected".) Say it once more.

296.2 chēhuò — traffic accident; car crash

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for right there on the spot, then the Mandarin for something unexpected.

You'll want to know: chēhuò

chēhuò — "traffic accident; car crash".

tā zài chēhuò lǐ shòushāng le — He was hurt in a car crash.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chēhuò is built from 车 'a vehicle' and *huò* 'a disaster', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhae* and *hwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'harm'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēhuò*
- *Say it: chēhuò*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài chēhuò lǐ shòushāng le* — He was hurt in a car crash.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for right there on the spot, then the Mandarin for something unexpected, then say *chēhuò* again

Before you move on

What does chēhuò mean? ("Traffic accident; car crash".) Say it once more.

296.3 shāchē — to put on the brakes; a brake

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for something unexpected, then the Mandarin for a car crash.

You'll want to know: shāchē

shāchē — "to put on the brakes; a brake".

kuài shāchē, bùrán jiù zhuàng le — Brake, quick, or we'll hit it!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāchē is built from *shā* 'to stop' and 车 'a vehicle'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun lists the first as *tsrhaet*, 'the pillar of a temple', the source of its other reading chà; the shā of 'to brake' has no source we can open, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāchē*
- *Say it: shāchē*, once more
- *Say it: kuài shāchē, bùrán jiù zhuàng le* — Brake, quick, or we'll hit it!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for something unexpected, then the Mandarin for a car crash, then say *shāchē* again

Before you move on

What does shāchē mean? ("To put on the brakes; a brake".) Say it once more.

296.4 新手 (xīnshǒu) — novice; beginner

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a car crash, then the Mandarin for to put on the brakes.

You'll want to know: 新手

新手 — *xīnshǒu* — "novice; beginner".

wǒ shì xīnshǒu, kāichē hěn màn — I'm a beginner, so I drive slowly.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

新手 (*xīnshǒu*) is built from 新 'new' and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a new hand, as in English.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnshǒu*
- *Say it: xīnshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shì xīnshǒu, kāichē hěn màn* — I'm a beginner, so I drive slowly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a car crash, then the Mandarin for to put on the brakes, then say *xīnshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 新手 mean? ("Novice; beginner".) Say it once more.

296.5 péiqián — to pay for damage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put on the brakes, then the Mandarin for a beginner at the wheel.

You'll want to know: péiqián

péiqián — "to pay for damage".

tā zhuàng le wǒ de chē, děi péiqián — He hit my car, so he has to pay for it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

péiqián is built from *péi* 'to make good a loss' and 钱 'money'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun has no entry for the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: péiqián*
- *Say it: péiqián*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhuàng le wǒ de chē, děi péiqián* — He hit my car, so he has to pay for it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put on the brakes, then the Mandarin for a beginner at the wheel, then say *péiqián* again

Before you move on

What does péiqián mean? ("To pay for damage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 297

Whose Fault

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who was to blame for an accident, what came of it and who dealt with it.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 297: I can say who was to blame for an accident, what came of it and who dealt with it.*

297.1 bǎoxiǎn — insurance

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a beginner at the wheel, then the Mandarin for to pay for damage.

You'll want to know: bǎoxiǎn

bǎoxiǎn — "insurance".

> *wǒ de chē yǒu bǎoxiǎn* — My car is insured.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: bǎo is said with a rising tone before xiǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎoxiǎn is built from *bǎo* 'to guard' and *xiǎn* 'danger', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *xjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to guard' and 'safe' and the second 'danger': a guard against danger.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎoxiǎn*
- *Say it: bǎoxiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de chē yǒu bǎoxiǎn* — My car is insured.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a beginner at the wheel, then the Mandarin for to pay for damage, then say *bǎoxiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does bǎoxiǎn mean? ("Insurance".) Say it once more.

297.2 事故 (shìgù) — accident

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay for damage, then the Mandarin for insurance for the car.

You'll want to know: 事故

事故 — *shìgù* — "accident".

这个路口常常发生事故 *zhège lùkǒu chángcháng fāshēng shìgù* — Accidents often happen at this crossing.

The new character, in pieces: 故 — nine strokes in two pieces, the right two pieces of 做 without its person piece: on the left 十 over 口, five strokes; on the right the striking piece, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

事故 (*shìgù*) is built from 事 'a matter' and 故, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzriH* and *kuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'old' and 'a matter'; how the pair came to mean an accident is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìgù*
- *Say it: shìgù*, once more
- *Say it: zhège lùkǒu chángcháng fāshēng shìgù* — Accidents often happen at this crossing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay for damage, then the Mandarin for insurance for the car, then say *shìgù* again

Before you move on

What does 事故 mean? ("Accident".) Say it once more.

297.3 故 — 十 over 口, then the striking piece

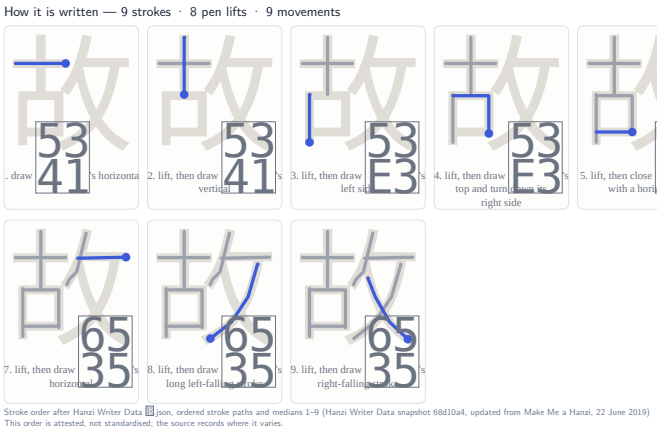
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shìgù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  做 十

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zuò*, *shí*

Script — 十 over 口, then the striking piece



How 故 is written, stroke by stroke

故

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, five strokes. 十: a bar and a vertical through it. Under it 口: a short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, and the bar that closes the foot.

The right piece, four strokes. The striking piece of 做: a sweep down to the left, a bar across to the right, a long sweep down to the lower left, and a long stroke falling to the right across it.

5 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 故, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 故? (**Two**.) Which character has the same two pieces on its right? (做.) What is on the left? (十 **over** 口.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 故, pinned stroke paths and medians.

297.4 zérèn — responsibility; blame

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for insurance for the car, then the Mandarin for a serious accident.

You'll want to know: zérèn

zérèn — "responsibility; blame".

> *shìgù fāshēng yǐhòu, sījī shuō shì tā de zérèn* — After the accident, the driver said it was his fault.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zérèn is built from *zé* 'to demand' and *rèn* 'to bear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsreak* and *nyim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to seek' and the second 'able to bear', and lists the second also in the departing tone, the source of rèn.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zérèn*
- *Say it: zérèn*, once more
- *Say it: shìgù fāshēng yǐhòu, sījī shuō shì tā de zérèn* — After the accident, the driver said it was his fault.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for insurance for the car, then the Mandarin for a serious accident, then say *zérèn* again

Before you move on

What does zérèn mean? ("Responsibility; blame".) Say it once more.

297.5 后果 (hòuguǒ) — consequences; what comes of it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a serious accident, then the Mandarin for who is to blame.

You'll want to know: 后果

后果 — *hòuguǒ* — "consequences; what comes of it".

kāichē tài kuài, hòuguǒ huì hěn yánzhòng — If you drive too fast, the consequences will be serious.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

后果 (*hòuguǒ*) is built from 后 'after' and 果 'fruit', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the fruit of a tree' and 'resolute': the fruit that comes after.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòuguǒ*
- *Say it: hòuguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: kāichē tài kuài, hòuguǒ huì hěn yánzhòng* — If you drive too fast, the consequences will be serious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a serious accident, then the Mandarin for who is to blame, then say *hòuguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does 后果 mean? ("Consequences; what comes of it".) Say it once more.

297.6 chǔlǐ — to deal with

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for who is to blame, then the Mandarin for what comes of it.

You'll want to know: chǔlǐ

chǔlǐ — "to deal with".

> *jǐngchá lái chǔlǐ le zhège shìgù* — The police came to deal with the accident.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: chǔ is said with a rising tone before lǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǔlǐ is built from *chǔ* 'to settle' and *lǐ* 'to put in order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhoX* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to dwell' and 'to settle' and the second 'to arrange' and 'reason'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǔlǐ*
- *Say it: chǔlǐ*, once more
- *Say it: jǐngchá lái chǔlǐ le zhège shìgù* — The police came to deal with the accident.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for who is to blame, then the Mandarin for what comes of it, then say *chǔlǐ* again

Before you move on

What does chǔlǐ mean? ("To deal with".) Say it once more.

Chapter 298

A Fire

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a fire, the firefighters and someone shouting for help.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 298: I can talk about a fire, the firefighters and someone shouting for help.*

298.1 huǒzāi — big fire; a fire that destroys buildings

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what comes of it, then the Mandarin for to deal with a problem.

You'll want to know: huǒzāi

huǒzāi — "big fire; a fire that destroys buildings".

> *huǒzāi de yuányīn shì shénme* — What caused the fire?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huǒzāi is built from 火 'fire' and *zāi* 'a disaster', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwaX* and *tsoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the second as a spelling of the word for fire sent from heaven.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huǒzāi*
- *Say it: huǒzāi*, once more
- *Say it: huǒzāi de yuányīn shì shénme* — What caused the fire?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what comes of it, then the Mandarin for to deal with a problem, then say *huǒzāi* again

Before you move on

What does huǒzāi mean? ("Big fire; a fire that destroys buildings".) Say it once more.

298.2 救火 (jiùhuǒ) — to fight a fire; to put out a fire

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to deal with a problem, then the Mandarin for a fire that destroys buildings.

You'll want to know: 救火

救火 — *jiùhuǒ* — "to fight a fire; to put out a fire".

大家都来救火了 *dàjiā dōu lái jiùhuǒ le* — Everyone came to fight the fire.

The new character, in pieces: 救 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left seven strokes, a bar, a vertical with a hook, a dot and a rising stroke on its left, a short sweep and a dot on its right, and a dot at the top right; on the right the striking piece of 故, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

救火 (*jiùhuǒ*) is built from 救 'to save' and 火 'fire', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjuwH* and *xwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to protect' and 'to stop': to stop a fire.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiùhuǒ*
- *Say it: jiùhuǒ*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu lái jiùhuǒ le* — Everyone came to fight the fire.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to deal with a problem, then the Mandarin for a fire that destroys buildings, then say *jiùhuǒ* again

Before you move on

What does 救火 mean? ("To fight a fire; to put out a fire".) Say it once more.

298.3 救 — a hooked post with small strokes, then the striking piece

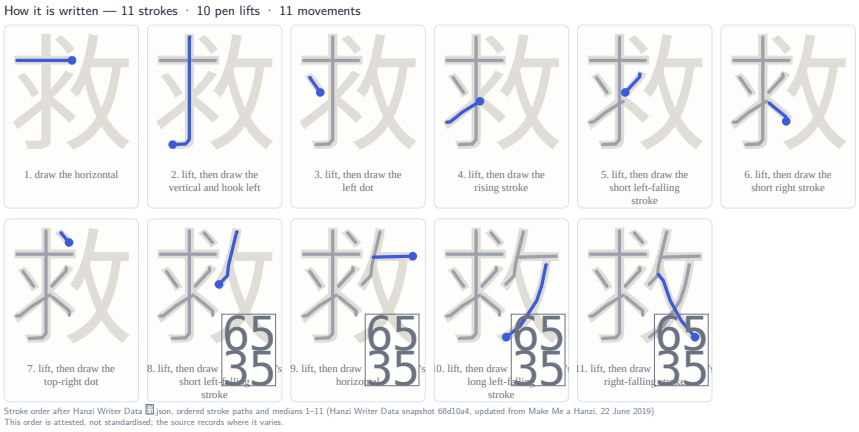
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiùhuǒ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  故 火

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *gù*, *huǒ*

Script — a hooked post with small strokes, then the striking piece



How 救 *is written, stroke by stroke*

救

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, seven strokes. A bar. A vertical down through it that hooks to the left at the foot. A dot on its left, then a stroke rising to the right below the dot. A short sweep down to the left on its right, then a short stroke falling to the right under that. Last, a dot high on the right, above the end of the bar.

The right piece, four strokes. The striking piece of 故: a sweep to the left, a bar, a long sweep to the lower left and a long stroke falling to the right.

7 + 4 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 救, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 救? (**Eleven**.) Which stroke of the left piece comes last? (**The dot high on the right**.) Where else have you made the right piece? (**In 故 and 做**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 救, pinned stroke paths and medians.

298.4 xiāofángyuán — firefighter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a fire that destroys buildings, then the Mandarin for to put out a fire.

You'll want to know: xiāofángyuán

xiāofángyuán — "firefighter".

xiāofángyuán hěn kuài jiù lái le — The firefighters were there in no time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāofángyuán is built from *xiāo* 'to put out', *fáng* 'to guard against' and *yuán* 'a member', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjew*, *bjang* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to put out', the second 'to keep off' and the third 'a count of things': one of those who put out fires.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāofángyuán*
- *Say it: xiāofángyuán*, once more
- *Say it: xiāofángyuán hěn kuài jiù lái le* — The firefighters were there in no time.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a fire that destroys buildings, then the Mandarin for to put out a fire, then say *xiāofángyuán* again

Before you move on

What does xiāofángyuán mean? ("Firefighter".) Say it once more.

298.5 hǎn — to shout; to call out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put out a fire, then the Mandarin for a firefighter.

You'll want to know: hǎn

hǎn — "to shout; to call out".

wǒ tīngdào yǒu rén zài hǎn — I heard someone shouting.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎn is inherited from Middle Chinese *xamX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'a sound'; the Guangyun also lists it under two other readings, *heamX* and *xeamX*, both glossed as a sound or a cry.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎn*
- *Say it: hǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ tīngdào yǒu rén zài hǎn* — I heard someone shouting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put out a fire, then the Mandarin for a firefighter, then say *hǎn* again

Before you move on

What does hǎn mean? (“To shout; to call out”.) Say it once more.

298.6 jiùmìng — help!; the cry for help

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a firefighter, then the Mandarin for to shout loudly.

You’ll want to know: jiùmìng

jiùmìng — “help!; the cry for help”.

tā dà hǎn jiùmìng — He shouted for help.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiùmìng is built from 救 ’to save’ and *mìng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjuwH* and *mjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the second ’to order’ and ’to send’; its sense ’a life’ is not given there.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiùmìng*
- *Say it: jiùmìng*, once more
- *Say it: tā dà hǎn jiùmìng* — He shouted for help.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a firefighter, then the Mandarin for to shout loudly, then say *jiùmìng* again

Before you move on

What does jiùmìng mean? (“Help!; the cry for help”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 299

Help Arrives

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say people were rescued in time, talk about first aid, and say the doctors fought to save a life.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 299: I can say people were rescued in time, talk about first aid, and say the doctors fought to save a life.*

299.1 得救 (déjiù) — to be rescued; to be saved from danger

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shout loudly, then the Mandarin for the cry for help.

You'll want to know: 得救

得救 — *déjiù* — "to be rescued; to be saved from danger".

> 事故发生以后大家都得救了 *shìgù fāshēng yǐhòu, dàjiā dōu déjiù le* — After the accident, everyone was rescued.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

得救 (*déjiù*) is built from 得 'to get' and 救 'to save', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tok* and *kjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to gain': to get saved.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: déjiù*
- *Say it: déjiù*, once more
- *Say it: shìgù fāshēng yǐhòu, dàjiā dōu déjiù le* — After the accident, everyone was rescued.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shout loudly, then the Mandarin for the cry for help, then say *déjiù* again

Before you move on

What does 得救 mean? ("To be rescued; to be saved from danger".) Say it once more.

299.2 jíshí — in time; promptly; before it was too late

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the cry for help, then the Mandarin for to be saved from danger.

You'll want to know: jíshí

jíshí — "in time; promptly; before it was too late".

yīshēng lái de hěn jíshí — The doctor came in good time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jíshí is built from *jí* 'to reach' and 时 'time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gip* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to arrive' and 'to catch up with': to catch the time.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jíshí*
- *Say it: jíshí*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng lái de hěn jíshí* — The doctor came in good time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the cry for help, then the Mandarin for to be saved from danger, then say *jíshí* again

Before you move on

What does jíshí mean? ("In time; promptly; before it was too late".) Say it once more.

299.3 jíjiù — first aid

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be saved from danger, then the Mandarin for before it was too late.

You'll want to know: jíjiù

jíjiù — "first aid".

wǒ xué guo jíjiù — I've done a first-aid course.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jíjiù is built from *jí* 'urgent' and 救 'to save', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kip* and *kjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'hurried'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jíjiù*
- *Say it: jíjiù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xué guo jíjiù* — I've done a first-aid course.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be saved from danger, then the Mandarin for before it was too late, then say *jíjiù* again

Before you move on

What does jíjiù mean? ("First aid".) Say it once more.

299.4 yūndǎo — to faint; to pass out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for before it was too late, then the Mandarin for first aid.

You'll want to know: yūndǎo

yūndǎo — "to faint; to pass out".

tā tūrán yūndǎo le — She suddenly fainted.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yūndǎo is built from *yūn* 'dizzy' and *dǎo* 'to fall over', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjunH* and *tawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a halo round the sun or moon' and the second 'to fall flat'. The sense 'dizzy' is not given there, and the level tone of yūn is irregular for *hjunH*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yūndǎo*
- *Say it: yūndǎo*, once more
- *Say it: tā tūrán yūndǎo le* — She suddenly fainted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for before it was too late, then the Mandarin for first aid, then say *yūndǎo* again

Before you move on

What does yūndǎo mean? ("To faint; to pass out".) Say it once more.

299.5 qiǎngjiù — to fight to save a patient; to give emergency treatment

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for first aid, then the Mandarin for to pass out.

You'll want to know: qiǎngjiù

qiǎngjiù — "to fight to save a patient; to give emergency treatment".

yīshēng zhèngzài qiǎngjiù tā — The doctors are fighting to save him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiǎngjiù is built from *qiǎng* 'to snatch' and 救 'to save', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjangX* and *kjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The Guangyun gives the first no gloss in this reading and glosses it 'to resist' and 'to dash' in the level tone; the sense 'to snatch' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiǎngjiù*
- *Say it: qiǎngjiù*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng zhèngzài qiǎngjiù tā* — The doctors are fighting to save him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for first aid, then the Mandarin for to pass out, then say *qiǎngjiù* again

Before you move on

What does qiǎngjiù mean? ("To fight to save a patient; to give emergency treatment".) Say it once more.

Chapter 300

Life and Death

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about an earthquake and an explosion, who died, and what they died of.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 300: I can talk about an earthquake and an explosion, who died, and what they died of.*

300.1 dìzhèn — earthquake

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pass out, then the Mandarin for to fight to save a patient.

You'll want to know: dìzhèn

dìzhèn — "earthquake".

> *zhèr yǐqián yǒu guo dìzhèn* — There was once an earthquake here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìzhèn is built from 地 'the ground' and *zhèn* 'to shake', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *tsyinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'thunder' and 'to move': the ground shaking.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìzhèn*
- *Say it: dìzhèn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr yǐqián yǒu guo dìzhèn* — There was once an earthquake here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pass out, then the Mandarin for to fight to save a patient, then say *dìzhèn* again

Before you move on

What does dìzhèn mean? ("Earthquake".) Say it once more.

300.2 死 (sǐ) — to die

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fight to save a patient, then the Mandarin for an earthquake.

You'll want to know: 死

死 — *sǐ* — "to die".

我的花都死了 *wǒ de huā dōu sǐ le* — All my flowers have died.

The new character, in pieces: 死 — six strokes: a long bar on top; under it on the left the evening piece of 外, three strokes; on the right a short sweep and a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up, as on the right of 比. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

死 (*sǐ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *sijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older dictionary for it: 'to be used up', what a person parts from.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǐ*
- *Say it: sǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de huā dōu sǐ le* — All my flowers have died.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fight to save a patient, then the Mandarin for an earthquake, then say *sǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 死 mean? ("To die".) Say it once more.

300.3 死 — a long bar over two small pieces

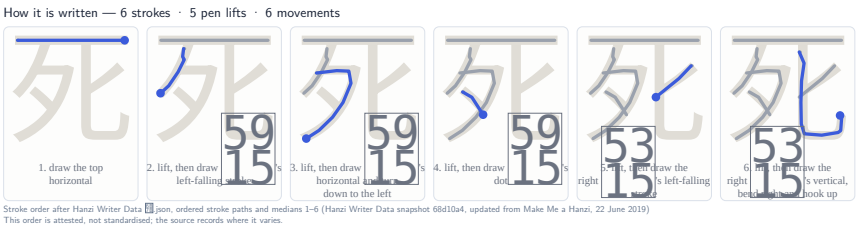
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *sǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

外 比 多

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wài*, *bǐ*, *duō*

Script — a long bar over two small pieces



How 死 is written, stroke by stroke

死

Three pieces: a bar on top, then two side by side under it.
The bar, one stroke, long, across the top.
Under it on the left, three strokes. The evening piece on the left of 外: a short sweep, a bar that turns into a long sweep to the lower left, and a dot.
On the right, two strokes. The right half of 比: a short sweep down to the left, then a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up.
1 + 3 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 死, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 死? (**Six**.) What comes first? (**The long bar on top**.) Where have you made the right piece? (**On the right of 比**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 死, pinned stroke paths and medians.

300.4 shēngmìng — the life of a living thing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an earthquake, then the Mandarin for to die.

You'll want to know: shēngmìng

shēngmìng — "the life of a living thing".

měi ge rén de shēngmìng dōu hěn zhòngyào — Every person's life matters.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēngmìng is built from 生 'to live' and *mìng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *mjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to grow' and the second 'to order'; its sense 'a life' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngmìng*
- *Say it: shēngmìng*, once more
- *Say it: měi ge rén de shēngmìng dōu hěn zhòngyào* — Every person's life matters.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an earthquake, then the Mandarin for to die, then say *shēngmìng* again

Before you move on

What does shēngmìng mean? ("The life of a living thing".) Say it once more.

300.5 死因 (sǐyīn) — cause of death

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to die, then the Mandarin for the life of a living thing.

You'll want to know: 死因

死因 — *sǐyīn* — "cause of death".

他的死因是什么 *tā de sǐyīn shì shénme* — What did he die of?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

死因 (*sǐyīn*) is built from 死 'to die' and 因 'a cause', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sijX* and *'jin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to rely on' and 'a reason'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǐyīn*
- *Say it: sǐyīn*, once more
- *Say it: tā de sǐyīn shì shénme* — What did he die of?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to die, then the Mandarin for the life of a living thing, then say *sǐyīn* again

Before you move on

What does 死因 mean? ("Cause of death".) Say it once more.

300.6 bàozhà — to explode; to blow up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the life of a living thing, then the Mandarin for the cause of death.

You'll want to know: bàozhà

bàozhà — "to explode; to blow up".

zuótiān wǎnshang fāshēng le bàozhà — There was an explosion last night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàozhà is built from *bào* 'to burst' and *zhà* 'to blow apart'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *paewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'fire cracking'; the Guangyun has no entry for the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàozhà*
- *Say it: bàozhà*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān wǎnshang fāshēng le bàozhà* — There was an explosion last night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the life of a living thing, then the Mandarin for the cause of death, then say *bàozhà* again

Before you move on

What does bàozhà mean? ("To explode; to blow up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 301

Getting Out

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say people ran from danger, someone helped a person up, and it all went as expected.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 301: I can say people ran from danger, someone helped a person up, and it all went as expected.*

301.1 táo — to run away; to flee

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the cause of death, then the Mandarin for to blow up.

You'll want to know: táo

táo — "to run away; to flee".

> *fángzi zháohuǒ le, dàjiā kuài táo* — The house is on fire, everyone run!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

táo is inherited from Middle Chinese *daw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to go away', 'to avoid' and 'to flee'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: táo*
- *Say it: táo*, once more
- *Say it: fángzi zháohuǒ le, dàjiā kuài táo* — The house is on fire, everyone run!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the cause of death, then the Mandarin for to blow up, then say *táo* again

Before you move on

What does táo mean? ("To run away; to flee".) Say it once more.

301.2 huāng — flustered; in a panic

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to blow up, then the Mandarin for to flee from danger.

You'll want to know: huāng

huāng — "flustered; in a panic".

bié huāng, wǒmen xiān bàojǐng — Don't panic, let's call the police first.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huāng is inherited from Middle Chinese *xwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists it in a two-syllable word meaning 'dazed'. The level tone of huāng is irregular for *xwangX*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huāng*
- *Say it: huāng*, once more
- *Say it: bié huāng, wǒmen xiān bàojǐng* — Don't panic, let's call the police first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to blow up, then the Mandarin for to flee from danger, then say *huāng* again

Before you move on

What does huāng mean? ("Flustered; in a panic".) Say it once more.

301.3 fú — to help up; to hold up with a hand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to flee from danger, then the Mandarin for in a panic.

You'll want to know: fú

fú — "to help up; to hold up with a hand".

wǒ fú tā qǐlai — I helped him up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fú is inherited from Middle Chinese *bju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to hold up' and 'to help'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fú*
- *Say it: fú*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ fú tā qǐlai* — I helped him up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to flee from danger, then the Mandarin for in a panic, then say *fú* again

Before you move on

What does fú mean? ("To help up; to hold up with a hand".) Say it once more.

301.4 gǔzhé — to break a bone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in a panic, then the Mandarin for to help up someone who fell.

You'll want to know: gǔzhé

gǔzhé — "to break a bone".

tā de tuǐ gǔzhé le — He broke his leg.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǔzhé is built from *gǔ* 'a bone' and *zhé* 'to snap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwot* and *tsyet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'the core of the flesh' and the second 'to bend and break'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔzhé*
- *Say it: gǔzhé*, once more
- *Say it: tā de tuǐ gǔzhé le* — He broke his leg.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in a panic, then the Mandarin for to help up someone who fell, then say *gǔzhé* again

Before you move on

What does gǔzhé mean? ("To break a bone".) Say it once more.

301.5 果然 (guǒrán) — sure enough; as expected

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to help up someone who fell, then the Mandarin for to break a bone.

You'll want to know: 果然

果然 — *guǒrán* — "sure enough; as expected".

他说会下雨果然下雨了 *tā shuō huì xiàyǔ, guǒrán xiàyǔ le* — He said it would rain, and sure enough it did.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

果然 (*guǒrán*) is built from 果 'resolute' and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaX* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'resolute' and 'certain' and the second 'so, like this': so, for certain.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǒrán*
- *Say it: guǒrán*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō huì xiàyǔ, guǒrán xiàyǔ le* — He said it would rain, and sure enough it did.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to help up someone who fell, then the Mandarin for to break a bone, then say *guǒrán* again

Before you move on

What does 果然 mean? ("Sure enough; as expected".) Say it once more.

301.6 Looking back: from A Crash to Getting Out

Say the Mandarin for something unexpected and a car crash.

Your turn

- *Say it:* something unexpected, a car crash, to put on the brakes, a beginner at the wheel, to pay for damage
- *Say it:* insurance for the car, a serious accident, who is to blame, what comes of it, to deal with a problem
- *Say it:* a fire that destroys buildings, to put out a fire, a firefighter, to shout loudly, the cry for help
- *Say it:* to be saved from danger, before it was too late, first aid, to pass out, to fight to save a patient
- *Say it:* an earthquake, to die, the life of a living thing, the cause of death, to blow up
- *Say it:* to flee from danger, in a panic, to help up someone who fell, to break a bone, sure enough
- *Read it:* 故 救 死 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Something unexpected? (意外, *yìwài.*) A car crash? (*chēhuò.*) To put on the brakes? (*shāchē.*) A beginner at the wheel? (新手, *xīnshǒu.*) To pay for damage? (*péiqián.*) Insurance for the car? (*bǎoxiǎn.*) A serious accident? (事故, *shìgù.*) Who is to blame? (*zérèn.*) What comes of it? (后果, *hòuguǒ.*) To deal with a problem? (*chǔlǐ.*) A fire that destroys buildings? (*huǒzāi.*) To put out a fire? (救火, *jiùhuǒ.*) A firefighter? (*xiāofángyuán.*) To shout loudly?

(*hǎn.*) The cry for help? (*jiùmìng.*) To be saved from danger? (得救, *déjiù.*) Before it was too late? (*jíshí.*) First aid? (*jíjiù.*) To pass out? (*yūndǎo.*) To fight to save a patient? (*qiǎngjiù.*) An earthquake? (*dìzhèn.*) To die? (死, *sǐ.*) The life of a living thing? (*shēngmìng.*) The cause of death? (死因, *sǐyīn.*) To blow up? (*bàozhà.*) To flee from danger? (*táo.*) In a panic? (*huāng.*) To help up someone who fell? (*fú.*) To break a bone? (*gǔzhé.*) Sure enough? (果然, *guǒrán.*)

Chapter 302

A Baby on the Way

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a pregnancy, a newborn, twins, and a life that was saved.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 302: I can talk about a pregnancy, a newborn, twins, and a life that was saved.*

302.1 huáiyùn — to be pregnant; to be expecting a baby

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to break a bone, then the Mandarin for sure enough.

You'll want to know: huáiyùn

huáiyùn — "to be pregnant; to be expecting a baby".

> *tā huáiyùn le* — She's pregnant.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huáiyùn is built from *huái* 'to hold close' and *yùn* 'to carry a child', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweaj* and *yingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to embrace' and the second with this very word. *yingH* would regularly give yìng; the final

of yùn is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huáiyùn*
- *Say it: huáiyùn*, once more
- *Say it: tā huáiyùn le* — She's pregnant.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to break a bone, then the Mandarin for sure enough, then say *huáiyùn* again

Before you move on

What does huáiyùn mean? ("To be pregnant; to be expecting a baby".) Say it once more.

302.2 活 (huó) — to live; alive

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sure enough, then the Mandarin for to be expecting a baby.

You'll want to know: 活

活 — *huó* — "to live; alive".

他活了一百岁 *tā huó le yìbǎi suì* — He lived to a hundred.

The new character, in pieces: 活 — nine strokes in three pieces: the water piece of 洗 on the left, three strokes; then 千, three strokes; then 口 under it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

活 (*huó*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'not dead' and also 'the sound of flowing water'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huó*
- *Say it: huó*, once more
- *Say it: tā huó le yìbǎi suì* — He lived to a hundred.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sure enough, then the Mandarin for to be expecting a baby, then say *huó* again

Before you move on

What does 活 mean? ("To live; alive".) Say it once more.

302.3 活 — the water piece, 千, then 口

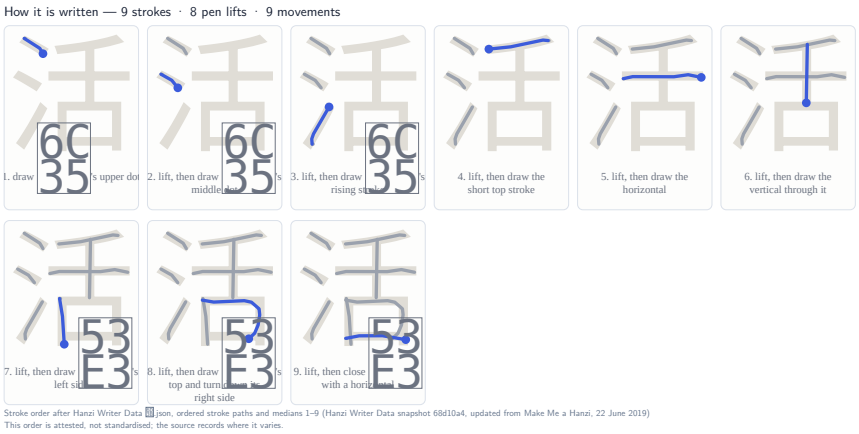
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *huó* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  洗 千

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xǐ*, *qiān*

Script — the water piece, 千, then 口



How 活 is written, stroke by stroke

活

Three pieces: the water piece on the left, then 千 over 口 on the right.

The water piece, three strokes. As on the left of 洗: two dots, then a stroke rising to the right.

千, three strokes. A short sweep down to the left, a bar across, and a vertical down through the bar.

口, three strokes, under 千: a short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, and the bar that closes the foot.

3 + 3 + 3 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 活, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 活? (**Three**.) What is on the left? (**The water piece, as in 洗.**) What is under 千? (口.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 活, pinned stroke paths and medians.

302.4 yīng'ér — newborn; infant

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be expecting a baby, then the Mandarin for to stay alive.

You'll want to know: yīng'ér

yīng'ér — "newborn; infant".

zhège yīng'ér hěn kě'ài — This baby is very sweet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīng'ér is built from *yīng* and 儿 'a child', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jieng* and *nye* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which quotes an older word list for the pair: a baby girl is *'jieng*, a baby boy *nye*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīng'ér*
- *Say it: yīng'ér*, once more
- *Say it: zhège yīng'ér hěn kě'ài* — This baby is very sweet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be expecting a baby, then the Mandarin for to stay alive, then say *yīng'ér* again

Before you move on

What does yīng'ér mean? ("Newborn; infant".) Say it once more.

302.5 救活 (jiùhuó) — to bring back to life

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stay alive, then the Mandarin for a newborn.

You'll want to know: 救活

救活 — *jiùhuó* — "to bring back to life".

医生救活了他 *yīshēng jiùhuó le tā* — The doctor brought him back to life.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

救活 (*jiùhuó*) is built from 救 'to save' and 活 'alive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjuwH* and *hwat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): to save and make alive.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiùhuó*
- *Say it: jiùhuó*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng jiùhuó le tā* — The doctor brought him back to life.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stay alive, then the Mandarin for a newborn, then say *jiùhuó* again

Before you move on

What does 救活 mean? ("To bring back to life".) Say it once more.

302.6 shuāngbāotāi — twins

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a newborn, then the Mandarin for to bring back to life.

You'll want to know: shuāngbāotāi

shuāngbāotāi — "twins".

> *tāmen shì shuāngbāotāi* — They're twins.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuāngbāotāi is built from *shuāng* 'a pair', *bāo* 'the womb' and *tāi* 'an unborn child', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sraewng*, *paew* and *thoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'two of a kind' and the third, quoting an older dictionary, 'three months with child', and gives the second only in the pair *bāotāi*, so its sense 'the womb' is not spelled out there: two from one womb.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuāngbāotāi*
- *Say it: shuāngbāotāi*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen shì shuāngbāotāi* — They're twins.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a newborn, then the Mandarin for to bring back to life, then say *shuāngbāotāi* again

Before you move on

What does shuāngbāotāi mean? ("Twins".) Say it once more.

Chapter 303

A Name and a School

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about naming a baby, a childhood name, nursery school and the start of term.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 303: I can talk about naming a baby, a childhood name, nursery school and the start of term.*

303.1 起名 (qǐmíng) — to name a baby; to give a name

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to bring back to life, then the Mandarin for a pair of twins.

You'll want to know: 起名

起名 — *qǐmíng* — "to name a baby; to give a name".

> *gěi háizi qǐmíng bù róngyì* — Choosing a name for a child isn't easy.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

起名 (*qǐmíng*) is built from 起 'to raise' and 名 'a name', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khiX* and *mjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and 'to start'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐmíng*
- *Say it: qǐmíng*, once more
- *Say it: gěi háizi qǐmíng bù róngyì* — Choosing a name for a child isn't easy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to bring back to life, then the Mandarin for a pair of twins, then say *qǐmíng* again

Before you move on

What does 起名 mean? ("To name a baby; to give a name".) Say it once more.

303.2 小名 (xiǎomíng) — childhood pet name

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pair of twins, then the Mandarin for to name a baby.

You'll want to know: 小名

小名 — *xiǎomíng* — "childhood pet name".

你的小名是什么 *nǐ de xiǎomíng shì shénme* — What was your pet name as a child?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小名 (*xiǎomíng*) is built from 小 'small' and 名 'a name', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *mjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the small name, used at home.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎomíng*
- *Say it: xiǎomíng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de xiǎomíng shì shénme* — What was your pet name as a child?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pair of twins, then the Mandarin for to name a baby, then say *xiǎomíng* again

Before you move on

What does 小名 mean? ("Childhood pet name".) Say it once more.

303.3 yòu'éryuán — kindergarten; nursery school

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to name a baby, then the Mandarin for a childhood pet name.

You'll want to know: yòu'éryuán

yòu'éryuán — "kindergarten; nursery school".

háizi sān suì de shíhou kāishǐ qù yòu'éryuán — The child started kindergarten at three.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yòu'éryuán is built from *yòu* 'young', 儿 'a child' and *yuán* 'a garden', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jiwH*, *nye* and *hjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'young' and the third 'a garden': a garden of young children.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yòu'éryuán*
- *Say it: yòu'éryuán*, once more
- *Say it: háizi sān suì de shíhou kāishǐ qù yòu'éryuán* — The child started kindergarten at three.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to name a baby, then the Mandarin for a childhood pet name, then say *yòu'éryuán* again

Before you move on

What does yòu'éryuán mean? ("Kindergarten; nursery school".) Say it once more.

303.4 开学 (kāixué) — to start the school term

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a childhood pet name, then the Mandarin for a kindergarten.

You'll want to know: 开学

开学 — *kāixué* — "to start the school term".

kāixué de shíhou, wǒ rènshi le tā — I got to know him when term started.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开学 (*kāixué*) is built from 开 'to open' and 学 'to study', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to open up': the opening of the school year.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāixué*
- *Say it: kāixué*, once more
- *Say it: kāixué de shíhou, wǒ rènshi le tā* — I got to know him when term started.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a childhood pet name, then the Mandarin for a kindergarten, then say *kāixué* again

Before you move on

What does 开学 mean? ("To start the school term".) Say it once more.

303.5 新生 (xīnshēng) — new student

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a kindergarten, then the Mandarin for to start the school term.

You'll want to know: 新生

新生 — *xīnshēng* — "new student".

新生下星期开学 *xīnshēng xià xīngqī kāixué* — The new students start next week.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

新生 (*xīnshēng*) is built from 新 'new' and 生, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to grow'; its sense 'a student' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnshēng*
- *Say it: xīnshēng*, once more
- *Say it: xīnshēng xià xīngqī kāixué* — The new students start next week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a kindergarten, then the Mandarin for to start the school term, then say *xīnshēng* again

Before you move on

What does 新生 mean? ("New student".) Say it once more.

Chapter 304

Starting School

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about starting school, signing in, the fees, and keeping a diary.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 304: I can talk about starting school, signing in, the fees, and keeping a diary.*

304.1 rùxué — to start school

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to start the school term, then the Mandarin for a new student at school.

You'll want to know: rùxué

rùxué — "to start school".

> *tā liù suì rùxué* — He started school at six.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rùxué is built from *rù* 'to enter' and 学 'to study', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyip* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'inside' and 'to take in'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: rùxué*
- *Say it: rùxué*, once more
- *Say it: tā liù suì rùxué* — He started school at six.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to start the school term, then the Mandarin for a new student at school, then say *rùxué* again

Before you move on

What does rùxué mean? ("To start school".) Say it once more.

304.2 日记 (rìjì) — diary

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a new student at school, then the Mandarin for to start school as a child.

You'll want to know: 日记

日记 — *rìjì* — "diary".

我小时候写过日记 *wǒ xiǎoshíhou xiě guo rìjì* — I kept a diary when I was little.

The new character, in pieces: 记 — five strokes in two pieces: the speech piece of 说 on the left, two strokes; on the right the right piece of 起, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

日记 (*rìjì*) is built from 日 'a day' and 记 'to note down', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyit* and *kiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to record'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: rìjì*
- *Say it: rìjì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎoshíhou xiě guo rìjì* — I kept a diary when I was little.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a new student at school, then the Mandarin for to start school as a child, then say *rìjì* again

Before you move on

What does 日记 mean? ("Diary".) Say it once more.

304.3 记 — the speech piece, then the right piece of 起

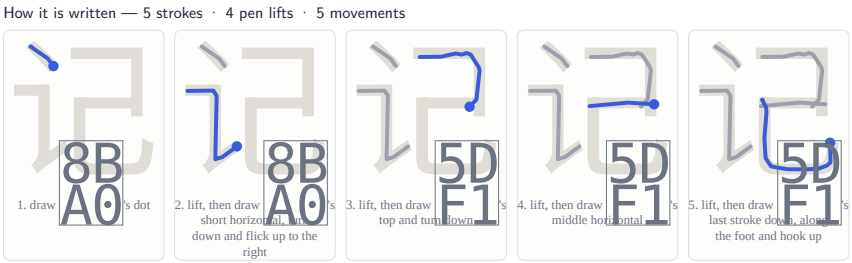
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *rìjì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  说 起

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shuō*, *qǐ*

Script — the speech piece, then the right piece of 起



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data .json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–5 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 记 is written, stroke by stroke

记

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, two strokes. The speech piece of 说: a dot, then a short stroke that runs right, turns down, and rises to the right at the foot.

The right piece, three strokes, as on the right of 起: a bar that turns down, a bar across the middle, then a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up.

2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 记, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 记? (**Two.**) What is the left piece? (**The speech piece, as in 说.**) Where have you made the right piece? (**On the right of 起.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 记, pinned stroke paths and medians.

304.4 报到 (bàodào) — to report in on arrival; to sign in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to start school as a child, then the Mandarin for a diary.

You'll want to know: 报到

报到 — *bàodào* — "to report in on arrival; to sign in".

新生明天来学校报到 *xīnshēng míngtiān lái xuéxiào bàodào* — The new students sign in at school tomorrow.

It sounds the same as *bàodào* 'to report the news'; this one means arriving and signing in.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

报到 (*bàodào*) is built from 报 'to report' and 到 'to arrive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawH* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to reach': to report that you have arrived.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàodào*
- *Say it: bàodào*, once more
- *Say it: xīnshēng míngtiān lái xuéxiào bàodào* — The new students sign in at school tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to start school as a child, then the Mandarin for a diary, then say *bàodào* again

Before you move on

What does 报到 mean? ("To report in on arrival; to sign in".) Say it once more.

304.5 xuéfèi — tuition fees

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a diary, then the Mandarin for to report in on arrival.

You'll want to know: xuéfèi

xuéfèi — "tuition fees".

dàxué de xuéfèi hěn guì — University fees are high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuéfèi is built from 学 'to study' and *fèi* 'to spend', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haewk* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to use up'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuéfèi*
- *Say it: xuéfèi*, once more
- *Say it: dàxué de xuéfèi hěn guì* — University fees are high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a diary, then the Mandarin for to report in on arrival, then say *xuéfèi* again

Before you move on

What does xuéfèi mean? ("Tuition fees".) Say it once more.

304.6 jìzhù — to commit to memory; to keep in mind

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to report in on arrival, then the Mandarin for school tuition fees.

You'll want to know: jìzhù

jìzhù — "to commit to memory; to keep in mind".

wǒ jìzhù le tā de diànhuà hàomǎ — I memorized his phone number.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìzhù is built from 𠂢 'to note down' and *zhù* 'to stay', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kiH* and *drjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to stop': noted so that it stays.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìzhù*
- *Say it: jìzhù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jìzhù le tā de diànhuà hàomǎ* — I memorized his phone number.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to report in on arrival, then the Mandarin for school tuition fees, then say *jìzhù* again

Before you move on

What does jìzhù mean? ("To commit to memory; to keep in mind".) Say it once more.

Chapter 305

Getting Engaged

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about going out with someone, a proposal, an engagement and a happy family occasion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 305: I can talk about going out with someone, a proposal, an engagement and a happy family occasion.*

305.1 tán liàn'ài — to go out with someone; to be in a relationship

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for school tuition fees, then the Mandarin for to commit to memory.

You'll want to know: tán liàn'ài

tán liàn'ài — "to go out with someone; to be in a relationship".

> *tāmen zài tán liàn'ài* — They're going out together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tán liàn'ài is built from *tán* 'to talk', *liàn* 'to long for' and *ài* 'love', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dam*, *ljwenH* and *'ojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to talk', the second 'to

long for' and the third 'to cherish': to talk love.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tán liàn'ài*
- *Say it: tán liàn'ài*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen zài tán liàn'ài* — They're going out together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for school tuition fees, then the Mandarin for to commit to memory, then say *tán liàn'ài* again

Before you move on

What does tán liàn'ài mean? ("To go out with someone; to be in a relationship".) Say it once more.

305.2 qiúhūn — to propose marriage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to commit to memory, then the Mandarin for to go out with someone.

You'll want to know: qiúhūn

qiúhūn — "to propose marriage".

tā zuótiān wǎnshang qiúhūn le — He proposed last night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiúhūn is built from *qiú* 'to seek' and *hūn* 'marriage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *xwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to search for' and the second 'marriage'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúhūn*
- *Say it: qiúhūn*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuótiān wǎnshang qiúhūn le* — He proposed last night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to commit to memory, then the Mandarin for to go out with someone, then say *qiúhūn* again

Before you move on

What does qiúhūn mean? ("To propose marriage".) Say it once more.

305.3 dìnghūn — to get engaged

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go out with someone, then the Mandarin for to propose marriage.

You'll want to know: dìnghūn

dìnghūn — "to get engaged".

tāmen shàng ge yuè dìnghūn le — They got engaged last month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìnghūn is built from *dìng* 'to agree on' and *hūn* 'marriage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dengX* and *xwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to discuss and settle' and the second 'marriage'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìnghūn*
- *Say it: dìnghūn*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen shàng ge yuè dìnghūn le* — They got engaged last month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go out with someone, then the Mandarin for to propose marriage, then say *dìnghūn* again

Before you move on

What does dìnghūn mean? ("To get engaged".) Say it once more.

305.4 喜事 (xǐshì) — a happy occasion; a wedding in the family

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to propose marriage, then the Mandarin for to get engaged.

You'll want to know: 喜事

喜事 — *xǐshì* — "a happy occasion; a wedding in the family".

我们家有喜事了 *wǒmen jiā yǒu xǐshì le* — There's a happy occasion in our family.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

喜事 (*xǐshì*) is built from 喜 'joy' and 事 'a matter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xiX* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'joy'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐshì*
- *Say it: xǐshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiā yǒu xǐshì le* — There's a happy occasion in our family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to propose marriage, then the Mandarin for to get engaged, then say *xǐshì* again

Before you move on

What does 喜事 mean? ("A happy occasion; a wedding in the family".) Say it once more.

305.5 xīnláng — bridegroom

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get engaged, then the Mandarin for a happy occasion.

You'll want to know: xīnláng

xīnláng — "bridegroom".

xīnláng jīntiān hěn shuài — The groom is very handsome today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnláng is built from 新 'new' and *láng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *lang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the title of an official; its use for a young man is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnláng*
- *Say it: xīnláng*, once more
- *Say it: xīnláng jīntiān hěn shuài* — The groom is very handsome today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get engaged, then the Mandarin for a happy occasion, then say *xīnláng* again

Before you move on

What does xīnláng mean? ("Bridegroom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 306

The Wedding

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the bride and the couple, the wedding sweets, and how the day went.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 306: I can talk about the bride and the couple, the wedding sweets, and how the day went.*

306.1 xīnniáng — bride

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a happy occasion, then the Mandarin for the bridegroom.

You'll want to know: xīnniáng

xīnniáng — "bride".

> *xīnniáng jīntiān tèbié piàoliang* — The bride is especially beautiful today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnniáng is built from 新 'new' and *niáng* 'a young woman', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *nrjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a title for a young woman.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnniáng*
- *Say it: xīnniáng*, once more
- *Say it: xīnniáng jīntiān tèbié piàoliang* — The bride is especially beautiful today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a happy occasion, then the Mandarin for the bridegroom, then say *xīnniáng* again

Before you move on

What does xīnniáng mean? ("Bride".) Say it once more.

306.2 经过 (jīngguò) — the sequence of events; what happened

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the bridegroom, then the Mandarin for the bride.

You'll want to know: 经过

经过 — *jīngguò* — "the sequence of events; what happened".

他说了那天的经过 *tā shuō le nà tiān de jīngguò* — He told us what happened that day.

The new character, in pieces: 经 — eight strokes in three pieces: the silk piece of 给 on the left, three strokes; on the right a fork of two strokes, a bar that turns into a sweep to the lower left and a short stroke falling to the right, over 工, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

经过 (*jīngguò*) is built from 经 'to pass through' and 过 'to go past', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keng* and *kwaH* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the warp of a cloth' and 'a path' and the second 'to cross' and 'to go beyond'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīngguò*
- *Say it: jīngguò*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō le nà tiān de jīngguò* — He told us what happened that day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the bridegroom, then the Mandarin for the bride, then say *jīngguò* again

Before you move on

What does 经过 mean? ("The sequence of events; what happened".) Say it once more.

306.3 经 — the silk piece, then a fork over 工

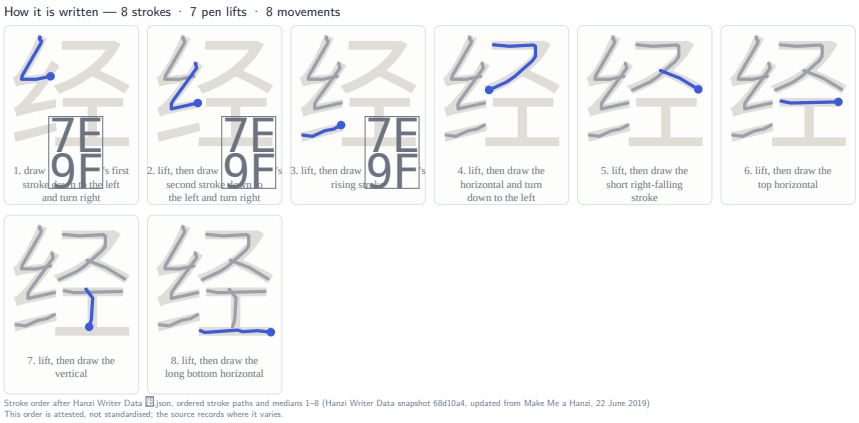
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jīngguò* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  给 工

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *gěi*, *gōng*

Script — the silk piece, then a fork over 工



How 经 is written, stroke by stroke

经

Three pieces: the silk piece on the left; on the right a fork over 工. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The silk piece, three strokes. As on the left of 给: two strokes that each drop to the left and turn to the right, then a stroke rising to the right.

The fork, two strokes. A bar that turns into a sweep down to the lower left, then a short stroke falling to the right.

工, three strokes: a short bar, a vertical, and a long bar across the foot.

3 + 2 + 3 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 经, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 经? (**Three**.) Where have you made the left piece? (**On the left of 给**.) What sits at the foot of the right side? (工.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 经, pinned stroke paths and medians.

306.4 新人 (xīnrén) — the bride and groom

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the bride, then the Mandarin for the whole story of what happened.

You'll want to know: 新人

新人 — *xīnrén* — "the bride and groom".

今天的新人是我的同学 *jīntiān de xīnrén shì wǒ de tóngxué* — The couple getting married today were my classmates.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

新人 (*xīnrén*) is built from 新 'new' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the new people, the couple who marry that day.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnrén*
- *Say it: xīnrén*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de xīnrén shì wǒ de tóngxué* — The couple getting married today were my classmates.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the bride, then the Mandarin for the whole story of what happened, then say *xīnrén* again

Before you move on

What does 新人 mean? ("The bride and groom".) Say it once more.

306.5 jǔxíng — to hold a ceremony; to hold an event

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the whole story of what happened, then the Mandarin for the bride and groom.

You'll want to know: jǔxíng

jǔxíng — "to hold a ceremony; to hold an event".

hūnlǐ zài zhōngwǔ jǔxíng — The wedding is at noon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǔxíng is built from *jǔ* 'to raise' and *xíng* 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjoX* and *haeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to lift' and 'to set moving' and the second 'to walk': to set going.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǔxíng*
- *Say it: jǔxíng*, once more
- *Say it: hūnlǐ zài zhōngwǔ jǔxíng* — The wedding is at noon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the whole story of what happened, then the Mandarin for the bride and groom, then say *jǔxíng* again

Before you move on

What does jǔxíng mean? ("To hold a ceremony; to hold an event".) Say it once more.

306.6 xǐtáng — wedding sweets

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the bride and groom, then the Mandarin for to hold a ceremony.

You'll want to know: xǐtáng

xǐtáng — "wedding sweets".

> *wǒmen chī le tāmen de xǐtáng* — We had sweets at their wedding.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǐtáng is built from 喜 'joy' and *táng* 'sugar', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xiX* and *dang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a sweet syrup'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐtáng*
- *Say it: xǐtáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen chī le tāmen de xǐtáng* — We had sweets at their wedding.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the bride and groom, then the Mandarin for to hold a ceremony, then say *xǐtáng* again

Before you move on

What does xǐtáng mean? ("Wedding sweets".) Say it once more.

Chapter 307

Marrying and Parting

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a honeymoon, breaking up, divorce and marrying again.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 307: I can talk about a honeymoon, breaking up, divorce and marrying again.*

307.1 fēnshǒu — to break up; to end a relationship

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hold a ceremony, then the Mandarin for wedding sweets for the guests.

You'll want to know: fēnshǒu

fēnshǒu — "to break up; to end a relationship".

> *tāmen fēnshǒu le, wǒ hěn nánguò* — They've split up, and I'm sad.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēnshǒu is built from *fēn* 'to part' and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjun* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to give out' and, quoting an

older dictionary, 'to separate': to part hands.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēnshǒu*
- *Say it: fēnshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen fēnshǒu le, wǒ hěn nánguò* — They've split up, and I'm sad.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hold a ceremony, then the Mandarin for wedding sweets for the guests, then say *fēnshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does fēnshǒu mean? ("To break up; to end a relationship".) Say it once more.

307.2 líhūn — to divorce

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for wedding sweets for the guests, then the Mandarin for to end a relationship.

You'll want to know: líhūn

líhūn — "to divorce".

tāmen jiéhūn shí nián yǐhòu líhūn le — They divorced after ten years of marriage.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

líhūn is built from 离 'to leave' and *hūn* 'marriage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lje* and *xwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'marriage'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: líhūn*
- *Say it: líhūn*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen jiéhūn shí nián yǐhòu líhūn le* — They divorced after ten years of marriage.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for wedding sweets for the guests, then the Mandarin for to end a relationship, then say *líhūn* again

Before you move on

What does líhūn mean? ("To divorce".) Say it once more.

307.3 zàihūn — to remarry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to end a relationship, then the Mandarin for to divorce.

You'll want to know: zàihūn

zàihūn — "to remarry".

tā líhūn yǐhòu, hěn kuài jiù zàihūn le — After his divorce he soon married again.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zàihūn is built from 再 'again' and *hūn* 'marriage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsojH* and *xwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'twice'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zàihūn*
- *Say it: zàihūn*, once more
- *Say it: tā líhūn yǐhòu, hěn kuài jiù zàihūn le* — After his divorce he soon married again.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to end a relationship, then the Mandarin for to divorce, then say *zàihūn* again

Before you move on

What does zàihūn mean? ("To remarry".) Say it once more.

307.4 mìyuè — honeymoon

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to divorce, then the Mandarin for to remarry.

You'll want to know: mìyuè

mìyuè — "honeymoon".

mìyuè de shíhou, wǒmen qù le hǎibiān — On our honeymoon we went to the seaside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mìyuè is built from *mì* 'honey' and 月 'a month', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjit* and *ngjwot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the food that bees make: the sweet month after a wedding.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: mìyuè*
- *Say it: mìyuè*, once more
- *Say it: mìyuè de shíhou, wǒmen qù le hǎibiān* — On our honeymoon we went to the seaside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to divorce, then the Mandarin for to remarry, then say *mìyuè* again

Before you move on

What does mìyuè mean? ("Honeymoon".) Say it once more.

307.5 hūnshā — wedding dress

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to remarry, then the Mandarin for a honeymoon.

You'll want to know: hūnshā

hūnshā — "wedding dress".

xīnniáng de hūnshā hěn piàoliang — The bride's dress is beautiful.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hūnshā is built from *hūn* 'marriage' and *shā* 'gauze', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwon* and *srae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a kind of silk'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hūnshā*
- *Say it: hūnshā*, once more
- *Say it: xīnniáng de hūnshā hěn piàoliang* — The bride's dress is beautiful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to remarry, then the Mandarin for a honeymoon, then say *hūnshā* again

Before you move on

What does hūnshā mean? ("Wedding dress".) Say it once more.

307.6 Looking back: from A Baby on the Way to Marrying and Parting

Say the Mandarin for to be expecting a baby and to stay alive.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to be expecting a baby, to stay alive, a newborn, to bring back to life, a pair of twins
- *Say it:* to name a baby, a childhood pet name, a kindergarten, to start the school term, a new student at school
- *Say it:* to start school as a child, a diary, to report in on arrival, school tuition fees, to commit to memory
- *Say it:* to go out with someone, to propose marriage, to get engaged, a happy occasion, the bridegroom
- *Say it:* the bride, the whole story of what happened, the bride and groom, to hold a ceremony, wedding sweets for the guests
- *Say it:* to end a relationship, to divorce, to remarry, a honeymoon, a white wedding dress
- *Read it:* 活 记 经 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To be expecting a baby? (*huáiyùn.*) To stay alive? (活, *huó.*) A newborn? (*yīng'ér.*) To bring back to life? (救活, *jiùhuó.*) A pair of twins? (*shuāngbāotāi.*) To name a baby? (起名, *qǐmíng.*) A childhood pet name? (小名, *xiǎomíng.*) A kindergarten? (*yòu'éryuán.*) To start the school term? (开学, *kāixué.*) A new student at school? (新生, *xīnshēng.*) To start school as a child? (*rùxué.*) A diary? (日记, *rìjì.*) To report in on arrival? (报到, *bàodào.*) School tuition fees? (*xuéfèi.*) To commit to memory? (*jìzhù.*) To go out with someone? (*tán liàn'ài.*) To propose marriage? (*qiúhūn.*) To get engaged? (*dìnghūn.*) A happy occasion? (喜事, *xǐshì.*) The bridegroom? (*xīnláng.*) The bride? (*xīnniáng.*) The whole story of what happened? (经过, *jīngguò.*) The bride and groom? (新人, *xīnrén.*) To hold a ceremony? (*jǔxíng.*) Wedding sweets for the guests? (*xǐtáng.*) To end a relationship? (*fēnshǒu.*) To divorce? (*líhūn.*) To remarry? (*zàihūn.*) A honeymoon? (*mìyuè.*) A white wedding dress? (*hūnshā.*)

Chapter 308

Ever Since

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say since when, where someone comes from, and that a person went missing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 308: I can say since when, where someone comes from, and that a person went missing.*

308.1 shīzōng — to go missing

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a honeymoon, then the Mandarin for a white wedding dress.

You'll want to know: shīzōng

shīzōng — "to go missing".

> *nàge háizi shīzōng le* — That child has gone missing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīzōng is built from *shī* 'to lose' and *zōng* 'a footprint', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *tsjowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a mistake' and 'to let go' and the second 'tracks': the trail is lost.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīzōng*
- *Say it: shīzōng*, once more
- *Say it: nàge háizi shīzōng le* — That child has gone missing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a honeymoon, then the Mandarin for a white wedding dress, then say *shīzōng* again

Before you move on

What does shīzōng mean? ("To go missing".) Say it once more.

308.2 自从 (zìcóng) — since; ever since

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a white wedding dress, then the Mandarin for to go missing.

You'll want to know: 自从

自从 — *zìcóng* — "since; ever since".

> 自从那天以后我天天写日记 *zìcóng nà tiān yǐhòu, wǒ tiāntiān xiě rìjì* — Since that day, I've kept a diary every day.

The new character, in pieces: 自 — six strokes: a short sweep down to the left on top, then a tall frame: a vertical, a bar that turns down the right side, two bars inside, and the bar that closes the foot, like 日 grown taller. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

自从 (*zìcóng*) is built from 自 'from' and 从 'from', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *dzjowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'from' and 'by way of' and the second 'to go along with'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìcóng*
- *Say it: zìcóng*, once more
- *Say it: zìcóng nà tiān yǐhòu, wǒ tiāntiān xiě rìjì* — Since that day, I've kept a diary every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a white wedding dress, then the Mandarin for to go missing, then say *zìcóng* again

Before you move on

What does 自从 mean? ("Since; ever since".) Say it once more.

308.3 自 — a short sweep over a tall frame

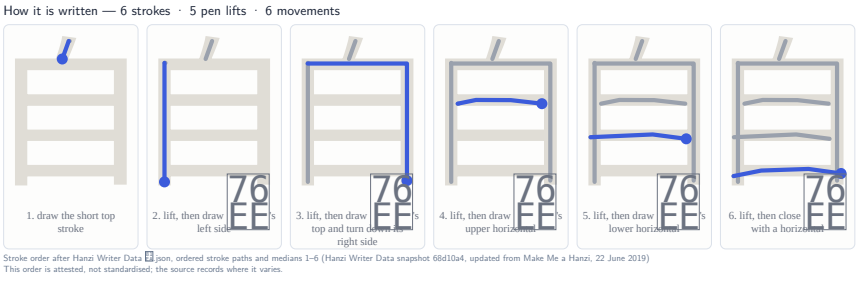
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zìcóng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

日 白

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *bái*

Script — a short sweep over a tall frame



How 自 is written, stroke by stroke

自

Two pieces: a short sweep on top, a tall frame under it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The sweep, one stroke: short, down to the left, at the top middle.

The frame, five strokes, built like 日: a vertical down the left; a bar across the top that turns down the right side; two bars inside; then the bar that closes the foot.

1 + 5 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 自, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 自? (**Six**.) What comes first? (**The short sweep on top**.) How many bars inside the frame? (**Two**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 自, pinned stroke paths and medians.

308.4 来自 (láizì) — to come from

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go missing, then the Mandarin for ever since.

You'll want to know: 来自

来自 — *láizì* — "to come from".

来自中国的新生经常来我家 *láizì Zhōngguó de xīnshēng jīngcháng lái wǒ jiā* — The new students from China often come to our house.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

来自 (*láizì*) is built from 来 'to come' and 自 'from', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *loj* and *dzijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to arrive'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: láizì*
- *Say it: láizì*, once more
- *Say it: láizì Zhōngguó de xīnshēng jīngcháng lái wǒ jiā* — The new students from China often come to our house.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go missing, then the Mandarin for ever since, then say *láizì* again

Before you move on

What does 来自 mean? ("To come from".) Say it once more.

308.5 fànzuì — to commit a crime

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ever since, then the Mandarin for to come from a place.

You'll want to know: fànzuì

fànzuì — "to commit a crime".

tā shuō tā méiyǒu fànzuì — He says he hasn't committed any crime.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fànzuì is built from *fàn* 'to violate' and *zuì* 'a crime', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjomX* and *dzwojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to trespass' and 'to violate' and records that the second was once written with another character.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fànzuì*
- *Say it: fànzuì*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō tā méiyǒu fànzuì* — He says he hasn't committed any crime.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ever since, then the Mandarin for to come from a place, then say *fànzuì* again

Before you move on

What does fànzuì mean? ("To commit a crime".) Say it once more.

308.6 pàichūsuǒ — local police station

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come from a place, then the Mandarin for to commit a crime.

You'll want to know: pàichūsuǒ

pàichūsuǒ — "local police station".

wǒmen qù pàichūsuǒ bàojǐng — We went to the police station to report it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pàichūsuǒ is built from *pài*, 出 'out' and 所 'a place', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *pheaH*, *tsyhwit* and *srjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a branch of a river'; its sense 'to send' is not given there. The place that sends officers out.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: pàichūsuǒ*
- *Say it: pàichūsuǒ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù pàichūsuǒ bàojǐng* — We went to the police station to report it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come from a place, then the Mandarin for to commit a crime, then say *pàichūsuǒ* again

Before you move on

What does pàichūsuǒ mean? ("Local police station".) Say it once more.

Chapter 309

A Thief

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a robbery, a thief, a con man and something done on purpose.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 309: I can talk about a robbery, a thief, a con man and something done on purpose.*

309.1 qiǎngjié — to rob by force

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to commit a crime, then the Mandarin for the local police station.

You'll want to know: qiǎngjié

qiǎngjié — "to rob by force".

> *yǒu rén qiǎngjié le zhè jiā yínháng* — Someone robbed this bank.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiǎngjié is built from *qiǎng* 'to snatch' and *jié* 'to plunder', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjangX* and *kjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to rob by force'; the sense 'to snatch' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiǎngjié*
- *Say it: qiǎngjié*, once more
- *Say it: yǒu rén qiǎngjié le zhè jiā yínháng* — Someone robbed this bank.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to commit a crime, then the Mandarin for the local police station, then say *qiǎngjié* again

Before you move on

What does qiǎngjié mean? ("To rob by force".) Say it once more.

309.2 小偷 (xiǎotōu) — thief

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the local police station, then the Mandarin for to rob by force.

You'll want to know: 小偷

小偷 — *xiǎotōu* — "thief".

小偷偷了我的钱包 *xiǎotōu tōu le wǒ de qiánbāo* — A thief stole my wallet.

The new character, in pieces: 偷 — eleven strokes in two pieces: the person piece of 你 on the left, two strokes; on the right a roof of two strokes with a short bar under it, then 月 on the left and the two strokes on the right of 到. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小偷 (*xiǎotōu*) is built from 小 'small' and 偷 'to steal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *thuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to rob'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎotōu*
- *Say it: xiǎotōu*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎotōu tōu le wǒ de qiánbāo* — A thief stole my wallet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the local police station, then the Mandarin for to rob by force, then say *xiǎotōu* again

Before you move on

What does 小偷 mean? ("Thief".) Say it once more.

309.3 偷 — the person piece, then a roof over 月 and two posts

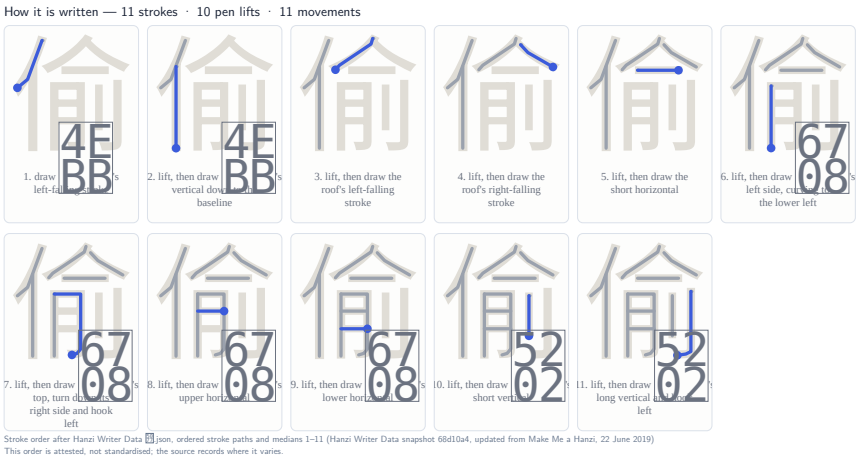
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiǎotōu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  你 到

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǐ*, *dào*

Script — the person piece, then a roof over 月 and two posts



How 偷 is written, stroke by stroke

偷

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, two strokes. The person piece of 你: a short sweep down to the left, then a vertical.

The right piece, nine strokes, top to bottom. A roof: a sweep down to the left and a long stroke falling to the right. A short bar under it. Then, side by side, 月 on the left, four strokes, and on the right the two strokes on the right of 到: a short vertical and a long vertical that hooks to the left.

2 + 9 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 偷, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 偷? (**Two.**) What is under the roof and the bar? (**月, and the two strokes on the right of 到.**) Which

stroke is last? (**The long vertical that hooks to the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 偷, pinned stroke paths and medians.

309.4 piàn — to cheat; to con

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to rob by force, then the Mandarin for a thief.

You'll want to know: piàn

piàn — "to cheat; to con".

tā piàn le wǒ de qián — He conned me out of my money.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

piàn No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: piàn*
- *Say it: piàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā piàn le wǒ de qián* — He conned me out of my money.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to rob by force, then the Mandarin for a thief, then say *piàn* again

Before you move on

What does piàn mean? ("To cheat; to con".) Say it once more.

309.5 piànzi — swindler; con man

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a thief, then the Mandarin for to con someone.

You'll want to know: piànzi

piànzi — "swindler; con man".

nàge rén shì piànzi — That man is a con man.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

piànzi is built from *piàn* 'to con' and the noun ending *zi*. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun has no entry for the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: piànzi*
- *Say it: piànzi*, once more
- *Say it: nàge rén shì piànzi* — That man is a con man.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a thief, then the Mandarin for to con someone, then say *piànzi* again

Before you move on

What does piànzi mean? ("Swindler; con man".) Say it once more.

309.6 故意 (gùyì) — on purpose; deliberately

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to con someone, then the Mandarin for a con man.

You'll want to know: 故意

故意 — *gùyì* — "on purpose; deliberately".

> 他故意不说话 *tā gùyì bù shuōhuà* — He's keeping quiet on purpose.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

故意 (*gùyì*) is built from 故 and 意 'an intention', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuH* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'old' and 'a matter' and the second 'will'; how the pair came to mean 'on purpose' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gùyì*
- *Say it: gùyì*, once more
- *Say it: tā gùyì bù shuōhuà* — He's keeping quiet on purpose.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to con someone, then the Mandarin for a con man, then say *gùyì* again

Before you move on

What does 故意 mean? ("On purpose; deliberately".) Say it once more.

Chapter 310

Who Did It

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a suspect, a witness and evidence, lying and owning up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 310: I can talk about a suspect, a witness and evidence, lying and owning up.*

310.1 huáiyí — to suspect; to doubt

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a con man, then the Mandarin for on purpose.

You'll want to know: huáiyí

huáiyí — "to suspect; to doubt".

> *jǐngchá huáiyí tā shì xiǎotōu* — The police suspect he's the thief.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huáiyí is built from *huái* 'to hold close' and *yí* 'to doubt', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweaj* and *ngi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to embrace' and 'to think of' and the second 'unsure' and 'to suspect': to hold a doubt.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huáiyí*
- *Say it: huáiyí*, once more
- *Say it: jǐngchá huáiyí tā shì xiǎotōu* — The police suspect he's the thief.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a con man, then the Mandarin for on purpose, then say *huáiyí* again

Before you move on

What does huáiyí mean? ("To suspect; to doubt".) Say it once more.

310.2 zhèngrén — witness

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for on purpose, then the Mandarin for to suspect someone.

You'll want to know: zhèngrén

zhèngrén — "witness".

tā shì zhège shìgù de zhèngrén — He's a witness to the accident.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhèngrén is built from *zhèng* 'proof' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyingH* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to verify'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngrén*
- *Say it: zhèngrén*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì zhège shìgù de zhèngrén* — He's a witness to the accident.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for on purpose, then the Mandarin for to suspect someone, then say *zhèngrén* again

Before you move on

What does zhèngrén mean? ("Witness".) Say it once more.

310.3 zhèngjù — evidence; proof

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to suspect someone, then the Mandarin for a witness to a crime.

You'll want to know: zhèngjù

zhèngjù — "evidence; proof".

jǐngchá zhǎodào le zhèngjù — The police found the evidence.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhèngjù is built from *zhèng* 'to verify' and *jù* 'to lean on', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyingH* and *kjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to rely on' and 'to hold': what a proof can lean on.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngjù*
- *Say it: zhèngjù*, once more
- *Say it: jǐngchá zhǎodào le zhèngjù* — The police found the evidence.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to suspect someone, then the Mandarin for a witness to a crime, then say *zhèngjù* again

Before you move on

What does zhèngjù mean? ("Evidence; proof".) Say it once more.

310.4 shuōhuǎng — to lie; to tell a lie

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a witness to a crime, then the Mandarin for proof of what happened.

You'll want to know: shuōhuǎng

shuōhuǎng — "to lie; to tell a lie".

wǒ juéde tā zài shuōhuǎng — I think he's lying.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuōhuǎng is built from 说 'to say' and *huǎng* 'a lie'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *sywet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the Guangyun has no entry for the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuōhuǎng*
- *Say it: shuōhuǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde tā zài shuōhuǎng* — I think he's lying.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a witness to a crime, then the Mandarin for proof of what happened, then say *shuōhuǎng* again

Before you move on

What does shuōhuǎng mean? ("To lie; to tell a lie".) Say it once more.

310.5 chéngrèn — to admit; to own up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for proof of what happened, then the Mandarin for to tell a lie.

You'll want to know: chéngrèn

chéngrèn — "to admit; to own up".

zuìhòu tā chéngrèn le — In the end he owned up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngrèn is built from *chéng* 'to receive' and *rèn* 'to recognize', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzying* and *nyinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to receive' and the second 'to know'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngrèn*
- *Say it: chéngrèn*, once more
- *Say it: zuìhòu tā chéngrèn le* — In the end he owned up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for proof of what happened, then the Mandarin for to tell a lie, then say *chéngrèn* again

Before you move on

What does chéngrèn mean? ("To admit; to own up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 311

The Police Car

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about an investigation, a police car, a chase, an alarm and the traffic police.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 311: I can talk about an investigation, a police car, a chase, an alarm and the traffic police.*

311.1 diàochá — to investigate

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to tell a lie, then the Mandarin for to own up to something.

You'll want to know: diàochá

diàochá — "to investigate".

> *jǐngchá zhèngzài diàochá zhège shìgù* — The police are investigating the accident.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diàochá is built from *diào* 'to choose' and *chá*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dewH* and *dzrae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to select' and the second 'wood floating in water'; how the pair came to mean 'to investigate' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: diàochá*
- *Say it: diàochá*, once more
- *Say it: jǐngchá zhèngzài diàochá zhège shìgù* — The police are investigating the accident.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to tell a lie, then the Mandarin for to own up to something, then say *diàochá* again

Before you move on

What does diàochá mean? ("To investigate".) Say it once more.

311.2 警车 (jǐngchē) — police car

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to own up to something, then the Mandarin for to investigate a case.

You'll want to know: 警车

警车 — *jǐngchē* — "police car".

小偷看到警车就走了 *xiǎotōu kàndào jǐngchē, jiù zǒu le* — The thief saw the police car and left.

The new character, in pieces: 警 — nineteen strokes in three pieces: top left, the grass piece of 花, then a two-stroke wrap with 口 inside; top right, the striking piece of 救; across the foot a dot, three bars and 口. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

警车 (*jǐngchē*) is built from 警 'to warn' and 车 'a vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengX* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to wake' and 'to guard

against’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐngchē*
- *Say it: jǐngchē*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎotōu kàndào jǐngchē, jiù zǒu le* — The thief saw the police car and left.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to own up to something, then the Mandarin for to investigate a case, then say *jǐngchē* again

Before you move on

What does 警车 mean? (“Police car”.) Say it once more.

311.3 警 — three pieces: top left, top right and the foot

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jǐngchē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  花 救

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *huā*, *jiù*

Script — three pieces: top left, top right and the foot

How 警 is written, stroke by stroke

警

Three pieces: two side by side on top, one across the foot. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

Top left, eight strokes. The grass piece of 花: a bar and two short verticals. Under it a short sweep to the left and a stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks back. Inside, 口.

Top right, four strokes. The striking piece of 救: a sweep to the left, a bar, a long sweep to the lower left and a long stroke falling to the right.

The foot, seven strokes. A dot. A long bar across, then two shorter bars. Then 口 under them.

8 + 4 + 7 = nineteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 警, all nineteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 警? (**Three.**) Which piece sits across the foot? (**A dot, three bars and 口.**) Where have you made the top right piece? (**In 救 and 故.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 警, pinned stroke paths and medians.

311.4 zhuī — to chase; to run after

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to investigate a case, then the Mandarin for a police car.

You'll want to know: zhuī

zhuī — "to chase; to run after".

jǐngchá zài zhuī xiǎotōu — The police are chasing the thief.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuī is inherited from Middle Chinese *trwij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to chase' and 'to follow'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuī*
- *Say it: zhuī*, once more
- *Say it: jǐngchá zài zhuī xiǎotōu* — The police are chasing the thief.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to investigate a case, then the Mandarin for a police car, then say *zhuī* again

Before you move on

What does zhuī mean? ("To chase; to run after".) Say it once more.

311.5 警报 (jǐngbào) — alarm; a warning siren

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a police car, then the Mandarin for to run after someone.

You'll want to know: 警报

警报 — *jǐngbào* — "alarm; a warning siren".

有警报大家快走 *yǒu jǐngbào, dàjiā kuài zǒu* — There's an alarm, everyone out, quick!

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

警报 (*jǐngbào*) is built from 警 'to warn' and 报 'to report', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengX* and *pawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a warning sent out.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐngbào*
- *Say it: jǐngbào*, once more
- *Say it: yǒu jǐngbào, dàjiā kuài zǒu* — There's an alarm, everyone out, quick!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a police car, then the Mandarin for to run after someone, then say *jǐngbào* again

Before you move on

What does 警报 mean? ("Alarm; a warning siren".) Say it once more.

311.6 jiāojǐng — traffic police officer

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to run after someone, then the Mandarin for a warning siren.

You'll want to know: jiāojǐng

jiāojǐng — "traffic police officer".

> *jiāojǐng shuō wǒ kāichē tài kuài* — The traffic officer said I was driving too fast.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāojǐng is built from *jiāo* 'to cross' and 警 'to warn', a short form of a longer name for the police of the roads; both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaew* and *kjaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to join'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāojǐng*
- *Say it: jiāojǐng*, once more
- *Say it: jiāojǐng shuō wǒ kāichē tài kuài* — The traffic officer said I was driving too fast.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to run after someone, then the Mandarin for a warning siren, then say *jiāojǐng* again

Before you move on

What does jiāojǐng mean? ("Traffic police officer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 312

Locked Up

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about fines, fights and prison, and say someone got what they deserved.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 312: I can talk about fines, fights and prison, and say someone got what they deserved.*

312.1 jiānyù — prison

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a warning siren, then the Mandarin for a traffic police officer.

You'll want to know: jiānyù

jiānyù — "prison".

> *tā zài jiānyù lǐ zhù le sān nián* — He spent three years in prison.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiānyù is built from *jiān* 'to watch over' and *yù* 'a jail', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaem* and *ngjowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to oversee' and explains the shape of the second as two dogs on guard.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiānyù*
- *Say it: jiānyù*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài jiānyù lǐ zhù le sān nián* — He spent three years in prison.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a warning siren, then the Mandarin for a traffic police officer, then say *jiānyù* again

Before you move on

What does jiānyù mean? ("Prison".) Say it once more.

312.2 fákuǎn — to impose a fine; a penalty fine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a traffic police officer, then the Mandarin for a prison.

You'll want to know: fákuǎn

fákuǎn — "to impose a fine; a penalty fine".

kāichē tài kuài yào fákuǎn — Driving too fast gets you a fine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fákuǎn is built from *fá* 'to punish' and *kuǎn* 'a sum', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjot* and *khwanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a punishment' and the second 'sincere'; its sense 'a sum of money' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fákuǎn*
- *Say it: fákuǎn*, once more
- *Say it: kāichē tài kuài yào fákuǎn* — Driving too fast gets you a fine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a traffic police officer, then the Mandarin for a prison, then say *fákuǎn* again

Before you move on

What does fákuǎn mean? ("To impose a fine; a penalty fine".) Say it once more.

312.3 dǎjià — to fight; to get into a fistfight

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a prison, then the Mandarin for to impose a fine.

You'll want to know: dǎjià

dǎjià — "to fight; to get into a fistfight".

liǎng ge rén zhèngzài ménkǒu dǎjià — Two people were fighting at the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎjià is built from 打 'to hit' and *jià* 'a frame', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike' and the second 'a roof frame'; how the pair came to mean a fight is not settled, and dǎ is an irregular outcome of *taengX*.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎjià*
- *Say it: dǎjià*, once more
- *Say it: liǎng ge rén zhèngzài ménkǒu dǎjià* — Two people were fighting at the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a prison, then the Mandarin for to impose a fine, then say *dǎjià* again

Before you move on

What does dǎjià mean? ("To fight; to get into a fistfight".) Say it once more.

312.4 活该 (huógāi) — it serves them right; serves you right

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to impose a fine, then the Mandarin for to get into a fistfight.

You'll want to know: 活该

活该 — *huógāi* — "it serves them right; serves you right".

活该他经常偷东西 *huógāi, tā jīngcháng tōu dōngxi* — Serves him right, he steals all the time.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

活该 (*huógāi*) is built from 活 'alive' and 该 'ought', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwat* and *koj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'complete' and 'all'; how the pair came to mean 'it serves you right' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huógāi*
- *Say it: huógāi*, once more
- *Say it: huógāi, tā jīngcháng tōu dōngxi* — Serves him right, he steals all the time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to impose a fine, then the Mandarin for to get into a fistfight, then say *huógāi* again

Before you move on

What does 活该 mean? ("It serves them right; serves you right".) Say it once more.

312.5 死活 (sǐhuó) — no matter what; whatever anyone says

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get into a fistfight, then the Mandarin for it serves them right.

You'll want to know: 死活

死活 — *sǐhuó* — "no matter what; whatever anyone says".

他死活不去报警 *tā sǐhuó bú qù bàojǐng* — Whatever anyone said, he wouldn't go to the police.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

死活 (*sǐhuó*) is built from 死 'to die' and 活 'to live', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sijX* and *hwat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): dead or alive, whatever happens.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǐhuó*
- *Say it: sǐhuó*, once more
- *Say it: tā sǐhuó bú qù bàojǐng* — Whatever anyone said, he wouldn't go to the police.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get into a fistfight, then the Mandarin for it serves them right, then say *sǐhuó* again

Before you move on

What does 死活 mean? ("No matter what; whatever anyone says".) Say it once more.

312.6 Looking back: from Ever Since to Locked Up

Say the Mandarin for to go missing and ever since.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to go missing, ever since, to come from a place, to commit a crime, the local police station
- *Say it:* to rob by force, a thief, to con someone, a con man, on purpose
- *Say it:* to suspect someone, a witness to a crime, proof of what happened, to tell a lie, to own up to something
- *Say it:* to investigate a case, a police car, to run after someone, a warning siren, a traffic police officer
- *Say it:* a prison, to impose a fine, to get into a fistfight, it serves them right, whatever anyone says
- *Read it:* 自 偷 警 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To go missing? (*shīzōng.*) Ever since? (自从, *zìcóng.*) To come from a place? (来自, *láizì.*) To commit a crime? (*fànzuì.*) The local police station? (*pàichūsuǒ.*) To rob by force? (*qiǎngjié.*) A thief? (小偷, *xiǎotōu.*) To con someone? (*piàn.*) A con man? (*piànzi.*) On purpose? (故意, *gùyì.*) To suspect someone? (*huáiyí.*) A witness to a crime? (*zhèngrén.*) Proof of what happened? (*zhèngjù.*) To tell a lie? (*shuōhuǎng.*) To own up to something? (*chéngrèn.*) To investigate a case? (*diàochá.*) A police car? (警车, *jǐngchē.*) To run after someone? (*zhuī.*) A warning siren? (警报, *jǐngbào.*) A traffic police officer? (*jiāojǐng.*) A prison? (*jiānyù.*) To impose a fine? (*fákuǎn.*) To get into a fistfight? (*dǎjià.*) It serves them right? (活该, *huógāi.*) Whatever anyone says? (死活, *sǐhuó.*)

Chapter 313

Moving House

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about doing up a new home, settling down and getting used to a new place.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 313: I can talk about doing up a new home, settling down and getting used to a new place.*

313.1 zhuāngxiū — to do up a home; to renovate

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for it serves them right, then the Mandarin for whatever anyone says.

You'll want to know: zhuāngxiū

zhuāngxiū — "to do up a home; to renovate".

> *wǒmen de xīn jiā zhèngzài zhuāngxiū* — Our new home is being done up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuāngxiū is built from *zhuāng* 'to pack' and *xiū* 'to repair', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrjang* and *sjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to pack for a journey' and the second 'to put in order'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuāngxiū*
- *Say it: zhuāngxiū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de xīn jiā zhèngzài zhuāngxiū* — Our new home is being done up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for it serves them right, then the Mandarin for whatever anyone says, then say *zhuāngxiū* again

Before you move on

What does zhuāngxiū mean? ("To do up a home; to renovate".) Say it once more.

313.2 才 (cái) — only then; not until

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for whatever anyone says, then the Mandarin for to renovate a flat.

You'll want to know: 才

才 — *cái* — "only then; not until".

他十点才来 *tā shí diǎn cái lái* — He didn't come until ten.

The new character, in pieces: 才 — three strokes: a bar, a vertical that hooks to the left at the foot, and a long sweep down to the left across them: the hand piece of 打 with a sweep for its last stroke. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

才 (*cái*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'barely' under another, more complex spelling; the simple form, read the same, is a different word there,

glossed 'use', 'strength' and 'talent'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: cái*
- *Say it: cái*, once more
- *Say it: tā shí diǎn cái lái* — He didn't come until ten.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for whatever anyone says, then the Mandarin for to renovate a flat, then say *cái* again

Before you move on

What does 才 mean? ("Only then; not until".) Say it once more.

313.3 才 — a bar, a hooked post and a sweep

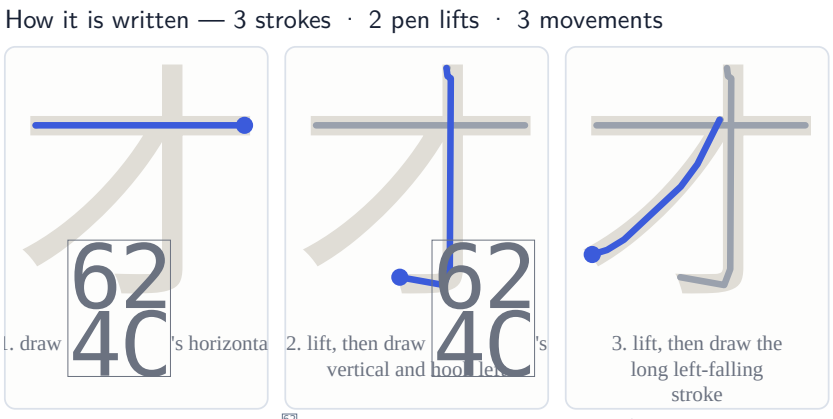
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *cái* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  打 十

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dǎ*, *shí*

Script — a bar, a hooked post and a sweep



How 才 is written, stroke by stroke

才

One piece, three strokes.
A bar across the top.
A vertical down through the bar, hooking to the left at the foot.
A long sweep from the crossing, down to the lower left, across the vertical. In 打 this stroke rises to the right; here it falls to the left.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 才, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 才? (**Three.**) How is it different from the hand piece of 打? (**The last stroke sweeps down to the left.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 才, pinned stroke paths and medians.

313.4 dìngjū — to settle down; to make a place your home

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to renovate a flat, then the Mandarin for not until then.

You'll want to know: dìngjū

dìngjū — "to settle down; to make a place your home".

tāmen zài Běijīng dìngjū le — They've settled in Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìngjū is built from *dìng* 'calm' and *jū* 'to dwell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dengH* and *kjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'at peace' and the second 'to dwell'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìngjū*
- *Say it: dìngjū*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen zài Běijīng dìngjū le* — They've settled in Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to renovate a flat, then the Mandarin for not until then, then say *dìngjū* again

Before you move on

What does dìngjū mean? ("To settle down; to make a place your home".) Say it once more.

313.5 shěbude — to hate to part with; to hate to leave

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for not until then, then the Mandarin for to make a place your home.

You'll want to know: shěbude

shěbude — "to hate to part with; to hate to leave".

wǒ shěbude líkāi zhèr — I hate to leave this place.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
The tone of 不 drops away here: it is said light, without a tone, shěbude.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shěbude is built from *shě* 'to let go', 不 'not' and 得 'to get', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *syaeX*, *pjut* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to release': not able to let go.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shěbude*
- *Say it: shěbude*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shěbude líkāi zhèr* — I hate to leave this place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for not until then, then the Mandarin for to make a place your home, then say *shěbude* again

Before you move on

What does shěbude mean? ("To hate to part with; to hate to leave".) Say it once more.

313.6 shìyìng — to adapt; to adjust to new surroundings

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a place your home, then the Mandarin for to hate to leave behind.

You'll want to know: shìyìng

shìyìng — "to adapt; to adjust to new surroundings".

wǒ hái bú shìyìng zhèr de shēnghuó — I'm not used to life here yet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shìyìng is built from *shì* 'to go to' and 应 'to answer', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syek* and *'ingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go to' and 'pleased' and the second 'to respond'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìyìng*
- *Say it: shìyìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hái bú shìyìng zhèr de shēnghuó* — I'm not used to life here yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a place your home, then the Mandarin for to hate to leave behind, then say *shìyìng* again

Before you move on

What does shìyìng mean? ("To adapt; to adjust to new surroundings".) Say it once more.

Chapter 314

Saying Goodbye

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a funeral: remembering a life, comforting someone, and tears at the graveside.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 314: I can talk about a funeral: remembering a life, comforting someone, and tears at the graveside.*

314.1 zànglǐ — funeral

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hate to leave behind, then the Mandarin for to adjust to new surroundings.

You'll want to know: zànglǐ

zànglǐ — "funeral".

> *dàjiā dōu cānjiā le tā de zànglǐ* — Everyone came to his funeral.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zànglǐ is built from *zàng* 'to bury' and *lǐ* 'a rite', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsangH* and *lejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hide away' and the second, quoting an older dictionary, 'what is done to serve the spirits'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zànglǐ*
- *Say it: zànglǐ*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu cānjiā le tā de zànglǐ* — Everyone came to his funeral.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hate to leave behind, then the Mandarin for to adjust to new surroundings, then say *zànglǐ* again

Before you move on

What does zànglǐ mean? ("Funeral".) Say it once more.

314.2 生前 (shēngqián) — in someone's lifetime; while they were alive

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to adjust to new surroundings, then the Mandarin for a funeral.

You'll want to know: 生前

生前 — *shēngqián* — "in someone's lifetime; while they were alive".

我还记得他生前很喜欢喝茶 *wǒ hái jìde tā shēngqián hěn xǐhuan hē chá* — I still remember how he loved his tea.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生前 (*shēngqián*) is built from 生 'life' and 前 'before', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): before, in life, said of someone who has died.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngqián*
- *Say it: shēngqián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hái jìde tā shēngqián hěn xǐhuan hē chá* — I still remember how he loved his tea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to adjust to new surroundings, then the Mandarin for a funeral, then say *shēngqián* again

Before you move on

What does 生前 mean? ("In someone's lifetime; while they were alive".) Say it once more.

314.3 ānwèi — to comfort; to console

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a funeral, then the Mandarin for in someone's lifetime.

You'll want to know: ānwèi

ānwèi — "to comfort; to console".

wǒ qù ānwèi tā — I'm going to comfort her.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ānwèi is built from *ān* 'calm' and *wèi* 'to soothe', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an* and *'jw+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second with this very word.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānwèi*
- *Say it: ānwèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù ānwèi tā* — I'm going to comfort her.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a funeral, then the Mandarin for in someone's lifetime, then say *ānwèi* again

Before you move on

What does ānwèi mean? ("To comfort; to console".) Say it once more.

314.4 mùdì — cemetery; graveyard

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in someone's lifetime, then the Mandarin for to comfort someone who is sad.

You'll want to know: mùdì

mùdì — "cemetery; graveyard".

mùdì lí zhèr hěn yuǎn — The cemetery is a long way from here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mùdì is built from *mù* 'a grave' and 地 'ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *muH* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a grave mound'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: mùdì*
- *Say it: mùdì*, once more
- *Say it: mùdì lí zhèr hěn yuǎn* — The cemetery is a long way from here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in someone's lifetime, then the Mandarin for to comfort someone who is sad, then say *mùdì* again

Before you move on

What does mùdì mean? ("Cemetery; graveyard".) Say it once more.

314.5 liúlèi — to shed tears

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to comfort someone who is sad, then the Mandarin for a cemetery.

You'll want to know: liúlèi

liúlèi — "to shed tears".

dàjiā dōu liúlèi le — Everyone was in tears.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúlèi is built from *liú* 'to flow' and *lèi* 'tears', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *lwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'water moving' and the second 'tears'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúlèi*
- *Say it: liúlèi*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu liúlèi le* — Everyone was in tears.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to comfort someone who is sad, then the Mandarin for a cemetery, then say *liúlèi* again

Before you move on

What does liúlèi mean? ("To shed tears".) Say it once more.

Chapter 315

Once Again

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say something happened again, that I feel at home now, and that some things are as before.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 315: I can say something happened again, that I feel at home now, and that some things are as before.*

315.1 jiànjiàn — gradually; little by little

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a cemetery, then the Mandarin for to shed tears.

You'll want to know: jiànjiàn

jiànjiàn — "gradually; little by little".

> *wǒ jiànjiàn xíguàn le zhèr de shēnghuó* — Little by little I got used to life here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiànjiàn is the word *jiàn* said twice, inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'step by step' and 'to advance'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànjiàn*
- *Say it: jiànjiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jiànjiàn xíguàn le zhèr de shēnghuó* — Little by little I got used to life here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a cemetery, then the Mandarin for to shed tears, then say *jiànjiàn* again

Before you move on

What does jiànjiàn mean? ("Gradually; little by little".) Say it once more.

315.2 又 (yòu) — yet again; it happened again

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shed tears, then the Mandarin for little by little.

You'll want to know: 又

又 — *yòu* — "yet again; it happened again".

你又来了 *nǐ yòu lái le* — Here you are again.

The new character, in pieces: 又 — two strokes: a bar that turns into a long sweep to the lower left, then a long stroke falling to the right across it, the fork at the foot of 报 and 发. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

又 (*yòu*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'further' and 'once more'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yòu*
- *Say it: yòu*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yòu lái le* — Here you are again.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shed tears, then the Mandarin for little by little, then say *yòu* again

Before you move on

What does 又 mean? ("Yet again; it happened again".) Say it once more.

315.3 又 — the fork at the foot of 报

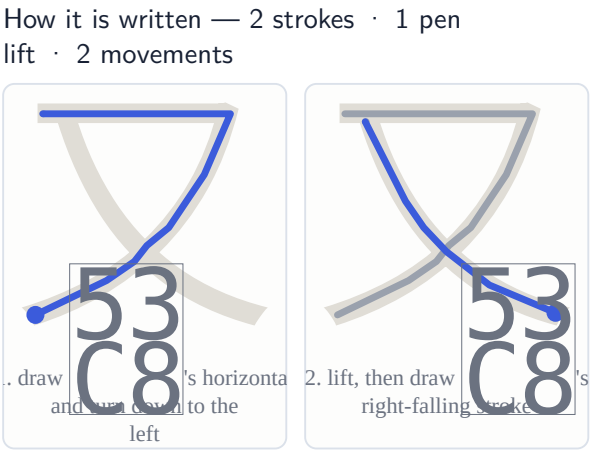
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yòu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  报 发

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bào*, *fā*

Script — the fork at the foot of 报



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 53.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–2 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 又 is written, stroke by stroke

又

One piece, two strokes.

A bar that turns into a sweep: across to the right, then a long sweep down to the lower left.

A long stroke falling to the right, from under the start of the bar, across the sweep to the foot.

You have made this fork in 报, 发 and 经.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 又, all two, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 又? (**Two.**) Where have you made this shape? (**At the foot of 报, and in 发 and 经.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 又, pinned stroke paths and medians.

315.4 自在 (zìzai) — at ease; free and relaxed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for little by little, then the Mandarin for it happened again.

You'll want to know: 自在

自在 — *zìzai* — "at ease; free and relaxed".

我来了一年才觉得自在 *wǒ lái le yì nián cái juéde zìzai* — It took me a year to feel at home.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

自在 (*zìzai*) is built from 自 'by oneself' and 在 'to be in place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *dzojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'from' and 'by way of'; the sense 'oneself' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìzai*
- *Say it: zìzai*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ lái le yì nián cái juéde zìzai* — It took me a year to feel at home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for little by little, then the Mandarin for it happened again, then say *zìzai* again

Before you move on

What does 自在 mean? ("At ease; free and relaxed".) Say it once more.

315.5 jìngrán — to my surprise; unexpectedly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for it happened again, then the Mandarin for at ease in a place.

You'll want to know: jìngrán

jìngrán — "to my surprise; unexpectedly".

tā jìngrán wàng le wǒ de shēngrì — He actually forgot my birthday!

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìngrán is built from *jìng* 'to the end' and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengH* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to use up' and 'the end'; how the pair came to mean 'to one's surprise' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìngrán*
- *Say it: jìngrán*, once more
- *Say it: tā jìngrán wàng le wǒ de shēngrì* — He actually forgot my birthday!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for it happened again, then the Mandarin for at ease in a place, then say *jìngrán* again

Before you move on

What does jìngrán mean? ("To my surprise; unexpectedly".) Say it once more.

315.6 réngrán — as before; even now

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at ease in a place, then the Mandarin for to my surprise.

You'll want to know: réngrán

réngrán — "as before; even now".

shí nián yǐhòu, tā réngrán zhù zài zhèr — Ten years later, he still lives here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

réngrán is built from *réng* 'to follow on' and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nying* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to follow', 'to repeat' and 'often'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: réngrán*
- *Say it: réngrán*, once more
- *Say it: shí nián yǐhòu, tā réngrán zhù zài zhèr* — Ten years later, he still lives here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at ease in a place, then the Mandarin for to my surprise, then say *réngrán* again

Before you move on

What does réngrán mean? (“As before; even now”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 316

A New Place

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about registering in a new town, getting to know it, and life there.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 316: I can talk about registering in a new town, getting to know it, and life there.*

316.1 dēngjì — to register officially

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to my surprise, then the Mandarin for the same as before.

You'll want to know: dēngjì

dēngjì — "to register officially".

> *wǒmen qù pàichūsuǒ dēngjì* — We went to the police station to register.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēngjì is built from *dēng* 'to go up' and 𠹳 'to note down', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong* and *kiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and 'to go forward': to enter in the record.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēngjì*
- *Say it: dēngjì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù pàichūsuǒ dēngjì* — We went to the police station to register.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to my surprise, then the Mandarin for the same as before, then say *dēngjì* again

Before you move on

What does dēngjì mean? ("To register officially".) Say it once more.

316.2 shúxī — to know well; to be familiar with

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the same as before, then the Mandarin for to register officially.

You'll want to know: shúxī

shúxī — "to know well; to be familiar with".

wǒ duì zhèr hái bù shúxī — I don't know this place well yet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shúxī is built from *shú* 'ripe' and *xī* 'in full', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyuwk* and *sit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'done' and the second 'in every detail'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shúxī*
- *Say it: shúxī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ duì zhèr hái bù shúxī* — I don't know this place well yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the same as before, then the Mandarin for to register officially, then say *shúxī* again

Before you move on

What does shúxī mean? ("To know well; to be familiar with".) Say it once more.

316.3 当地 (dāngdì) — of that place; in the place in question

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to register officially, then the Mandarin for to be familiar with.

You'll want to know: 当地

当地 — *dāngdì* — "of that place; in the place in question".

我到了当地才找到房子 *wǒ dào le dāngdì cái zhǎodào fángzi* — I only found somewhere to live once I got there.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当地 (*dāngdì*) is built from 当 'at' and 地 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *dijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to face' and 'to meet': the very place.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngdì*
- *Say it: dāngdì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dào le dāngdì cái zhǎodào fángzi* — I only found somewhere to live once I got there.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to register officially, then the Mandarin for to be familiar with, then say *dāngdì* again

Before you move on

What does 当地 mean? ("Of that place; in the place in question".) Say it once more.

316.4 人生 (rénshēng) — a person's life; life from birth to death

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be familiar with, then the Mandarin for of that place.

You'll want to know: 人生

人生 — *rénshēng* — "a person's life; life from birth to death".

rénshēng hěn cháng, nǐ kěyǐ chóngxīn kāishǐ — Life is long; you can start over.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

人生 (*rénshēng*) is built from 人 'a person' and 生 'to live', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyin* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: rénshēng*
- *Say it: rénshēng*, once more
- *Say it: rénshēng hěn cháng, nǐ kěyǐ chóngxīn kāishǐ* — Life is long; you can start over.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be familiar with, then the Mandarin for of that place, then say *rénshēng* again

Before you move on

What does 人生 mean? ("A person's life; life from birth to death".) Say it once more.

316.5 自然 (zìrán) — naturally; nature

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for of that place, then the Mandarin for life from birth to death.

You'll want to know: 自然

自然 — *zìrán* — "naturally; nature".

又下雨了我们自然不出门 *yòu xiàyǔ le, wǒmen zìrán bù chūmén* — It's raining again, so naturally we're staying in.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

自然 (*zìrán*) is built from 自 and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'from' and 'by way of'; its sense 'by itself' is not given there. So of itself.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìrán*
- *Say it: zìrán*, once more
- *Say it: yòu xiàyǔ le, wǒmen zìrán bù chūmén* — It's raining again, so naturally we're staying in.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for of that place, then the Mandarin for life from birth to death, then say *zìrán* again

Before you move on

What does 自然 mean? ("Naturally; nature".) Say it once more.

Chapter 317

Looking Back

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about growing up, marriage and family, and doing things ahead of time.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 317: I can talk about growing up, marriage and family, and doing things ahead of time.*

317.1 qīngnián — young people; youth

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for life from birth to death, then the Mandarin for as you would naturally expect.

You'll want to know: qīngnián

qīngnián — "young people; youth".

> *tā shì yí ge hěn yǒu nénglì de qīngnián* — He's a very capable young man.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīngnián is built from *qīng* 'green' and 年 'years', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsheng* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the colour of the east: green years.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīngnián*
- *Say it: qīngnián*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì yí ge hěn yǒu nénglì de qīngnián* — He's a very capable young man.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for life from birth to death, then the Mandarin for as you would naturally expect, then say *qīngnián* again

Before you move on

What does qīngnián mean? ("Young people; youth".) Say it once more.

317.2 chéngnián — to come of age; fully grown

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as you would naturally expect, then the Mandarin for young people.

You'll want to know: chéngnián

chéngnián — "to come of age; fully grown".

háizi chéngnián yǐhòu, jiù líkāi le jiā — Once the children were grown, they left home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngnián is built from *chéng* 'to complete' and 年 'years', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to finish' and 'to make'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngnián*
- *Say it: chéngnián*, once more
- *Say it: háizi chéngnián yǐhòu, jiù líkāi le jiā* — Once the children were grown, they left home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as you would naturally expect, then the Mandarin for young people, then say *chéngnián* again

Before you move on

What does chéngnián mean? ("To come of age; fully grown".) Say it once more.

317.3 hūnyīn — marriage; the bond of marriage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for young people, then the Mandarin for to come of age.

You'll want to know: hūnyīn

hūnyīn — "marriage; the bond of marriage".

tāmen de hūnyīn yǒu wèntí — Their marriage is in trouble.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hūnyīn is built from *hūn* and *yīn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwon* and *'jin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each with the pair itself, 'marriage', and explains *hūn* by the evening hour of old weddings.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hūnyīn*
- *Say it: hūnyīn*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen de hūnyīn yǒu wèntí* — Their marriage is in trouble.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for young people, then the Mandarin for to come of age, then say *hūnyīn* again

Before you move on

What does hūnyīn mean? ("Marriage; the bond of marriage".) Say it once more.

317.4 jiātíng — household; a family unit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come of age, then the Mandarin for a marriage.

You'll want to know: jiātíng

jiātíng — "household; a family unit".

wǒmen shì yí ge kuàilè de jiātíng — We're a happy family.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiātíng is built from 家 'home' and *tíng* 'a courtyard', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *deng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a gate yard': the home and its yard.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiātíng*
- *Say it: jiātíng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen shì yí ge kuàilè de jiātíng* — We're a happy family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come of age, then the Mandarin for a marriage, then say *jiātíng* again

Before you move on

What does jiātíng mean? ("Household; a family unit".) Say it once more.

317.5 事先 (shìxiān) — beforehand; in advance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a marriage, then the Mandarin for a household.

You'll want to know: 事先

事先 — *shìxiān* — "beforehand; in advance".

他又没有事先说我们都生气了 *tā yòu méiyǒu shìxiān shuō, wǒmen dōu shēngqì le* — Once again he didn't say so beforehand, and we were all cross.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

事先 (*shìxiān*) is built from 事 'a matter' and 先 'before', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzriH* and *sen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'first and after': before the matter.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìxiān*
- *Say it: shìxiān*, once more
- *Say it: tā yòu méiyǒu shìxiān shuō, wǒmen dōu shēngqì le* — Once again he didn't say so beforehand, and we were all cross.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a marriage, then the Mandarin for a household, then say *shìxiān* again

Before you move on

What does 事先 mean? ("Beforehand; in advance".) Say it once more.

317.6 Looking back: from Moving House to Looking Back

Say the Mandarin for to renovate a flat and not until then.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to renovate a flat, not until then, to make a place your home, to hate to leave behind, to adjust to new surroundings
- *Say it:* a funeral, in someone's lifetime, to comfort someone who is sad, a cemetery, to shed tears
- *Say it:* little by little, it happened again, at ease in a place, to my surprise, the same as before
- *Say it:* to register officially, to be familiar with, of that place, life from birth to death, as you would naturally expect
- *Say it:* young people, to come of age, a marriage, a household, in advance
- *Read it:* 才 又 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To renovate a flat? (*zhuāngxiū.*) Not until then? (才, *cái.*) To make a place your home? (*dìngjū.*) To hate to leave behind? (*shěbude.*) To adjust to new surroundings? (*shìyìng.*) A funeral? (*zànglǐ.*) In someone's lifetime? (生前, *shēngqián.*) To comfort someone who is sad? (*ānwèi.*) A cemetery? (*mùdì.*) To shed tears? (*liúlèi.*) Little by little? (*jiànjiàn.*) It happened again? (又, *yòu.*) At ease in a place? (自在, *zìzai.*) To my surprise? (*jìngrán.*) The same as before? (*réngrán.*) To register officially? (*dēngjì.*) To be familiar with? (*shúxī.*) Of that place? (当地, *dāngdì.*) Life from birth to death? (人生, *rénshēng.*) As you would naturally expect? (自然, *zìrán.*) Young people? (*qīngnián.*) To come of age? (*chéngnián.*) A marriage? (*hūnyīn.*) A household? (*jiātíng.*) In advance? (事先, *shìxiān.*)

317.7 Looking Back — once more

Say the Mandarin for young people and to come of age.

Your turn

- *Say it:* young people, to come of age, a marriage, a household, in advance

Before you move on

Young people? (*qīngnián.*) To come of age? (*chéngnián.*) A marriage? (*hūnyīn.*) A household? (*jiātíng.*) In advance? (事先, *shìxiān.*)

Chapter 318

Letters from Far Away

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a pen pal, an envelope and a postcard, wait for a reply and pass a message on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 318: I can talk about a pen pal, an envelope and a postcard, wait for a reply and pass a message on.*

318.1 bǐyǒu — pen pal

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for household, then the Mandarin for beforehand.

You'll want to know: bǐyǒu

bǐyǒu — "pen pal".

> *wǒ xiǎoshíhou yǒu yí ge bǐyǒu* — When I was little I had a pen pal.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: bǐ is said with a rising tone before yǒu, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǐyǒu is built from *bǐ* 'a pen' and *yǒu* 'a friend', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pit* and *hjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which names the first as the writing brush and glosses the second as

those who share one mind.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǐyǒu*
- *Say it: bǐyǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎoshíhou yǒu yí ge bǐyǒu* — When I was little I had a pen pal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for household, then the Mandarin for beforehand, then say *bǐyǒu* again

Before you move on

What does bǐyǒu mean? ("Pen pal".) Say it once more.

318.2 xìnfēng — envelope

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for beforehand, then the Mandarin for a pen pal.

You'll want to know: xìnfēng

xìnfēng — "envelope".

tā de xìnfēng lǐ yǒu yì zhāng zhàopiàn — There was a photo in his envelope.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìnfēng is built from *xìn* 'a letter' and *fēng* 'to seal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sinH* and *pjowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'loyal and true' and the second 'great', 'a domain' and 'a rank'; the senses 'a letter' and 'to

seal' are not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìnfēng*
- *Say it: xìnfēng*, once more
- *Say it: tā de xìnfēng lǐ yǒu yì zhāng zhàopiàn* — There was a photo in his envelope.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for beforehand, then the Mandarin for a pen pal, then say *xìnfēng* again

Before you move on

What does xìnfēng mean? ("Envelope".) Say it once more.

318.3 míngxìnpiàn — postcard

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pen pal, then the Mandarin for an envelope.

You'll want to know: míngxìnpiàn

míngxìnpiàn — "postcard".

tā cóng Zhōngguó gěi wǒ jì le yì zhāng míngxìnpiàn — He sent me a postcard from China.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

míngxìnpiàn is built from 明 'bright, open', *xìn* 'a letter' and *piàn* 'a flat piece', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjaeng*, *sinH* and *phenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'light' and the last 'half' and 'a split piece of wood'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngxìnpiàn*
- *Say it: míngxìnpiàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā cóng Zhōngguó gěi wǒ jì le yì zhāng míngxìnpiàn* — He sent me a postcard from China.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pen pal, then the Mandarin for an envelope, then say *míngxìnpiàn* again

Before you move on

What does míngxìnpiàn mean? ("Postcard".) Say it once more.

318.4 回音 (huíyīn) — reply; echo

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an envelope, then the Mandarin for a postcard.

You'll want to know: 回音

回音 — *huíyīn* — "reply; echo".

wǒ gěi tā xiě le xìn tā réngrán méiyǒu huíyīn — I wrote to him, and there's still no reply.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

回音 (*huíyīn*) is built from 回 'to turn back' and 音 'a sound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *'im* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn' and the second 'a sound'. A sound that comes back is an echo; the sense 'a reply' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huíyīn*
- *Say it: huíyīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gěi tā xiě le xìn tā réngrán méiyǒu huíyīn* — I wrote to him, and there's still no reply.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an envelope, then the Mandarin for a postcard, then say *huíyīn* again

Before you move on

What does 回音 mean? ("Reply; echo".) Say it once more.

318.5 zhuǎngào — to pass on a message

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a postcard, then the Mandarin for a reply to a letter.

You'll want to know: zhuǎngào

zhuǎngào — "to pass on a message".

qǐng nǐ zhuǎngào tā míngtiān wǒ bú qù le — Please tell him for me that I'm not going tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuǎngào is built from *zhuǎn* 'to turn' and *gào* 'to tell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjwenX* and *kawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move' and the second 'to report'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuǎngào*
- *Say it: zhuǎngào*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng nǐ zhuǎngào tā míngtiān wǒ bú qù le* — Please tell him for me that I'm not going tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a postcard, then the Mandarin for a reply to a letter, then say *zhuǎngào* again

Before you move on

What does zhuǎngào mean? ("To pass on a message".) Say it once more.

Chapter 319

Calls and Confidence

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I will call back, talk about calls coming in, keep in touch by letter and say I have confidence.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 319: I can say I will call back, talk about calls coming in, keep in touch by letter and say I have confidence.*

319.1 回电 (huídiàn) — to call back; to return a call

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a reply to a letter, then the Mandarin for to pass on a message.

You'll want to know: 回电

回电 — *huídiàn* — "to call back; to return a call".

> 我在开会一会儿给你回电 *wǒ zài kāihuì yíhuìr gěi nǐ huídiàn* — I'm in a meeting; I'll call you back in a moment.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

回电 (*huídiàn*) is built from 回 'to turn back' and 电 'electricity', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *denH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'lightning'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huídiàn*
- *Say it: huídiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài kāihuì yíhuìr gěi nǐ huídiàn* — I'm in a meeting; I'll call you back in a moment.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a reply to a letter, then the Mandarin for to pass on a message, then say *huídiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 回电 mean? ("To call back; to return a call".) Say it once more.

319.2 信心 (xìnxīn) — confidence; faith

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pass on a message, then the Mandarin for to return a call.

You'll want to know: 信心

信心 — *xìnxīn* — "confidence; faith".

我对你有信心 *wǒ duì nǐ yǒu xìnxīn* — I have faith in you.

The new character, in pieces: 信 — nine strokes: the person piece 亻 on the left; on the right a dot, three bars and 口. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

信心 (*xìnxīn*) is built from 信 'to trust' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sinH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'loyal and true' and 'sincere'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìnxīn*
- *Say it: xìnxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ duì nǐ yǒu xìnxīn* — I have faith in you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pass on a message, then the Mandarin for to return a call, then say *xìnxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 信心 mean? ("Confidence; faith".) Say it once more.

319.3 信 — the person piece, then a dot, three bars and 口

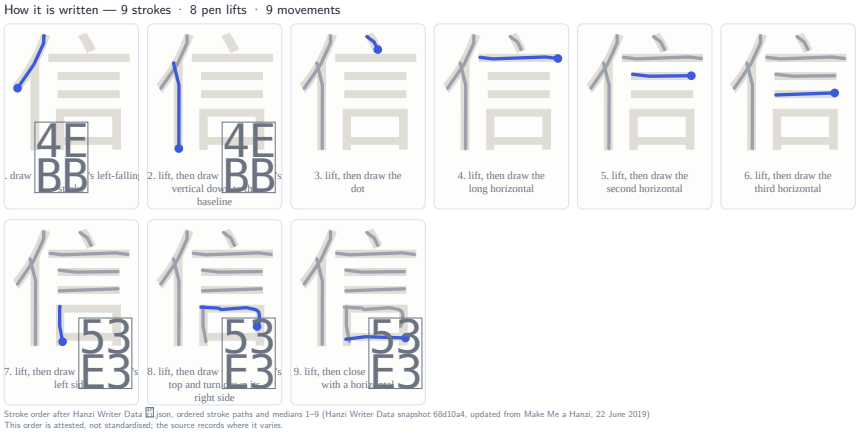
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xìnxīn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  你 说

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǐ*, *shuō*

Script — the person piece, then a dot, three bars and 口



How 信 is written, stroke by stroke

信

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 亻, two strokes. A stroke falling to the left, then a vertical down to the foot, as in 你.

The right piece, seven strokes, top to bottom. A dot. Three bars, the top one the longest. Then 口 at the foot: a short vertical, a bar that runs right and turns down, and the bar that closes it.

2 + 7 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 信, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 信? (**Nine.**) What is the left piece? (**亻, the person piece.**) What closes the right piece at the foot? (口.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 信, pinned stroke paths and medians.

319.4 来电 (láidiàn) — incoming call

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to return a call, then the Mandarin for confidence that it will work.

You'll want to know: 来电

来电 — *láidiàn* — "incoming call".

开会的时候我有三个来电 *kāihuì de shíhou wǒ yǒu sān ge láidiàn* — During the meeting three calls came in for me.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

来电 (*láidiàn*) is built from 来 'to come' and 电 'electricity', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *loj* and *denH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to arrive' and the second 'lightning'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: láidiàn*
- *Say it: láidiàn*, once more
- *Say it: kāihuì de shíhou wǒ yǒu sān ge láidiàn* — During the meeting three calls came in for me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to return a call, then the Mandarin for confidence that it will work, then say *láidiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 来电 mean? ("Incoming call".) Say it once more.

319.5 tōngxìn — to write to each other; to correspond

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for confidence that it will work, then the Mandarin for an incoming call.

You'll want to know: tōngxìn

tōngxìn — "to write to each other; to correspond".

wǒ hé wǒ de bǐyǒu tōngxìn le wǔ nián — My pen pal and I wrote to each other for five years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tōngxìn is built from *tōng* 'to get through' and 信 'a letter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thuwng* and *sinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to reach' and the second 'true'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōngxìn*
- *Say it: tōngxìn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hé wǒ de bǐyǒu tōngxìn le wǔ nián* — My pen pal and I wrote to each other for five years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for confidence that it will work, then the Mandarin for an incoming call, then say *tōngxìn* again

Before you move on

What does tōngxìn mean? ("To write to each other; to correspond".) Say it once more.

319.6 huàfèi — phone charges

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an incoming call, then the Mandarin for to write to each other.

You'll want to know: huàfèi

huàfèi — "phone charges".

> *zhège yuè huàfèi yìbǎi kuài* — This month's phone bill is a hundred yuan.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huàfèi is built from 话 'talk' and *fèi* 'a cost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwaejH* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to use up'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàfèi*
- *Say it: huàfèi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège yuè huàfèi yìbǎi kuài* — This month's phone bill is a hundred yuan.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an incoming call, then the Mandarin for to write to each other, then say *huàfèi* again

Before you move on

What does huàfèi mean? ("Phone charges".) Say it once more.

Chapter 320

On the Phone

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone hung up, dial a number, get through, bring something up and talk about a voice message.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 320: I can say someone hung up, dial a number, get through, bring something up and talk about a voice message.*

320.1 guàduàn — to hang up the phone; to end a call

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to write to each other, then the Mandarin for phone charges.

You'll want to know: guàduàn

guàduàn — "to hang up the phone; to end a call".

> *tā hái méi shuō wán jiù guàduàn le diànhuà* — He hung up before he had finished.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guàduàn is built from *guà* 'to hang' and *duàn* 'to cut off', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kweaH* and *dwanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to suspend' and the second 'to sever'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guàduàn*
- *Say it: guàduàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā hái méi shuō wán jiù guàduàn le diànhuà* — He hung up before he had finished.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to write to each other, then the Mandarin for phone charges, then say *guàduàn* again

Before you move on

What does guàduàn mean? ("To hang up the phone; to end a call".) Say it once more.

320.2 bōdǎ — to dial a number

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for phone charges, then the Mandarin for to end a call.

You'll want to know: bōdǎ

bōdǎ — "to dial a number".

yǒu shì qǐng bōdǎ zhège hàomǎ — If anything comes up, please call this number.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bōdǎ is built from *bō* and 扌丁 'to strike', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pat* and *taengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to set in order' and 'to remove' and the second 'to hit'. The sense 'to dial' is modern. Middle Chinese *taengX* would not regularly give dǎ.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bōdǎ*
- *Say it: bōdǎ*, once more
- *Say it: yǒu shì qǐng bōdǎ zhège hàomǎ* — If anything comes up, please call this number.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for phone charges, then the Mandarin for to end a call, then say *bōdǎ* again

Before you move on

What does bōdǎ mean? ("To dial a number".) Say it once more.

320.3 dǎtōng — to get through on the phone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to end a call, then the Mandarin for to dial a number.

You'll want to know: dǎtōng

dǎtōng — "to get through on the phone".

dì'èr tiān wǒ cái dǎtōng tā de diànhuà — I didn't get through to him until the next day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎtōng is built from 打 'to strike' and *tōng* 'to reach', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *thuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hit' and the second 'to reach'. Middle Chinese *taengX* would not regularly give dǎ: the modern vowel is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎtōng*
- *Say it: dǎtōng*, once more
- *Say it: dì'èr tiān wǒ cái dǎtōng tā de diànhuà* — I didn't get through to him until the next day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to end a call, then the Mandarin for to dial a number, then say *dǎtōng* again

Before you move on

What does dǎtōng mean? ("To get through on the phone".) Say it once more.

320.4 说起 (shuōqǐ) — to mention; to bring up a subject

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dial a number, then the Mandarin for to get through on the phone.

You'll want to know: 说起

说起 — *shuōqǐ* — "to mention; to bring up a subject".

他在信里说起了你 *tā zài xìn lǐ shuōqǐ le nǐ* — He mentioned you in his letter.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

说起 (*shuōqǐ*) is built from 说 'to say' and 起 'to rise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sywet* and *khiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tell' and the second 'to rise' and 'to stand up'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuōqǐ*
- *Say it: shuōqǐ*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài xìn lǐ shuōqǐ le nǐ* — He mentioned you in his letter.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dial a number, then the Mandarin for to get through on the phone, then say *shuōqǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 说起 mean? ("To mention; to bring up a subject".) Say it once more.

320.5 语音 (yǔyīn) — voice message; speech sounds

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get through on the phone, then the Mandarin for to bring up a subject.

You'll want to know: 语音

语音 — *yǔyīn* — "voice message; speech sounds".

wǒ tīng le māma de yǔyīn — I listened to my mum's voice message.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

语音 (*yǔyīn*) is built from 语 'speech' and 音 'a sound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjoX* and *'im* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to discuss' and the second 'a sound'. A recorded message is a modern sense.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǔyīn*
- *Say it: yǔyīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ tīng le māma de yǔyīn* — I listened to my mum's voice message.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get through on the phone, then the Mandarin for to bring up a subject, then say *yǔyīn* again

Before you move on

What does 语音 mean? ("Voice message; speech sounds".) Say it once more.

Chapter 321

People of Long Ago

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about history, the people of long ago, old books and old scripts.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 321: I can talk about history, the people of long ago, old books and old scripts.*

321.1 lìshǐ — history

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to bring up a subject, then the Mandarin for a voice message.

You'll want to know: lìshǐ

lìshǐ — "history".

> *wǒ zài dàxué xué guo Zhōngguó de lìshǐ* — I studied Chinese history at university.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lìshǐ is built from *lì* 'to pass through' and *shǐ* 'a record', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lek* and *sriX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go through' and calls the second 'one who records events'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: lìshǐ*
- *Say it: lìshǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài dàxué xué guo Zhōngguó de lìshǐ* — I studied Chinese history at university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to bring up a subject, then the Mandarin for a voice message, then say *lìshǐ* again

Before you move on

What does lìshǐ mean? ("History".) Say it once more.

321.2 古人 (gǔrén) — the ancients; people of long ago

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a voice message, then the Mandarin for the history of a country.

You'll want to know: 古人

古人 — *gǔrén* — "the ancients; people of long ago".

古人没有电话 *gǔrén méiyǒu diànhuà* — People long ago had no telephones.

The new character, in pieces: 古 — five strokes: 十 on top, and 口 under it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

古人 (*gǔrén*) is built from 古 'ancient' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'former'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔrén*
- *Say it: gǔrén*, once more
- *Say it: gǔrén méiyǒu diànhuà* — People long ago had no telephones.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a voice message, then the Mandarin for the history of a country, then say *gǔrén* again

Before you move on

What does 古人 mean? ("The ancients; people of long ago".) Say it once more.

321.3 古 — 十 over 口

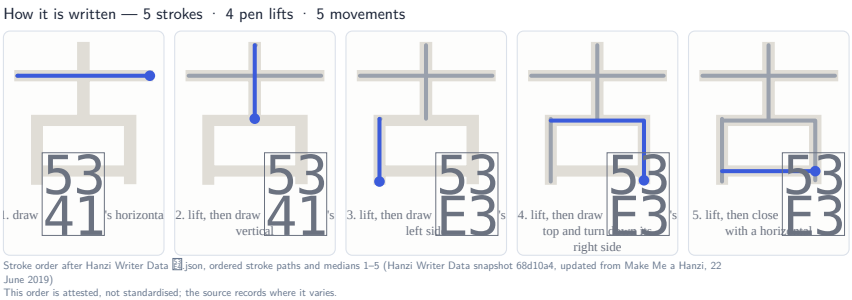
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gǔrén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

十 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shí*, *kǒu*

Script — 十 over 口



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 2.1 json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–5 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 古 is written, stroke by stroke

古

Two pieces, top to bottom.

The top piece, 十, two strokes. A long bar from left to right, then a vertical down through its middle.

The bottom piece, 口, three strokes. A short vertical on the left; a bar that runs right and turns down; then the bar that closes the foot.

2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 古, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 古? (**Five.**) What is on top? (十.) What is under it? (口.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 古, pinned stroke paths and medians.

321.4 古书 (gǔshū) — ancient book; old book

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the history of a country, then the Mandarin for the people of long ago.

You'll want to know: 古书

古书 — *gǔshū* — "ancient book; old book".

我在书店里看到了一本古书 *wǒ zài shūdiàn lǐ kàndào le yì běn gǔshū* — I came across an old book in the bookshop.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

古书 (*gǔshū*) is built from 古 'ancient' and 书 'a book', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *syo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'former' and says of the second

that it sets things down.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔshū*
- *Say it: gǔshū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài shūdiàn lǐ kàndào le yì běn gǔshū* — I came across an old book in the bookshop.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the history of a country, then the Mandarin for the people of long ago, then say *gǔshū* again

Before you move on

What does 古书 mean? ("Ancient book; old book".) Say it once more.

321.5 古老 (gǔlǎo) — ancient; age-old

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the people of long ago, then the Mandarin for an old book from long ago.

You'll want to know: 古老

古老 — *gǔlǎo* — "ancient; age-old".

他们家的房子很古老 *tāmen jiā de fángzi hěn gǔlǎo* — Their family's house is ancient.

Two third tones meet in this word: gǔ is said with a rising tone before lǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

古老 (*gǔlǎo*) is built from 古 'ancient' and 老 'old', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *lawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription),

which glosses the first 'former' and the second 'aged'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔlǎo*
- *Say it: gǔlǎo*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen jiā de fángzi hěn gǔlǎo* — Their family's house is ancient.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the people of long ago, then the Mandarin for an old book from long ago, then say *gǔlǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 古老 mean? ("Ancient; age-old".) Say it once more.

321.6 文字 (wénzì) — script; written language

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an old book from long ago, then the Mandarin for age-old.

You'll want to know: 文字

文字 — *wénzì* — "script; written language".

汉字是很古老的文字 *Hànzì shì hěn gǔlǎo de wénzì* — Chinese characters are a very old script.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

文字 (*wénzì*) is built from 文 'writing' and 字 'a character', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjun* and *dziH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'writing' and 'beautiful'; for the second it gives 'an ornament' and 'to nurse', and the sense 'a written character' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wénzì*
- *Say it: wénzì*, once more
- *Say it: Hànzì shì hěn gǔlǎo de wénzì* — Chinese characters are a very old script.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an old book from long ago, then the Mandarin for age-old, then say *wénzì* again

Before you move on

What does 文字 mean? ("Script; written language".) Say it once more.

Chapter 322

Back Then

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about back then, someone's early and later years, a whole life and missing the past.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 322: I can talk about back then, someone's early and later years, a whole life and missing the past.*

322.1 当年 (dāngnián) — back then; in those years

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for age-old, then the Mandarin for a script for a language.

You'll want to know: 当年

当年 — *dāngnián* — "back then; in those years".

> 当年他常常给我写信 *dāngnián tā chángcháng gěi wǒ xiě xìn* — Back then he often sent me letters.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当年 (*dāngnián*) is built from 当 'to face, that very' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to face' and 'to match' and says that when the grain ripens it is called a year.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngnián*
- *Say it: dāngnián*, once more
- *Say it: dāngnián tā chángcháng gěi wǒ xiě xìn* — Back then he often sent me letters.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for age-old, then the Mandarin for a script for a language, then say *dāngnián* again

Before you move on

What does 当年 mean? ("Back then; in those years".) Say it once more.

322.2 早年 (zǎonián) — one's early years; long ago

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a script for a language, then the Mandarin for in those years long ago.

You'll want to know: 早年

早年 — *zǎonián* — "one's early years; long ago".

他早年在外国工作过 *tā zǎonián zài wàiguó gōngzuò guo* — In his early years he worked abroad.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

早年 (*zǎonián*) is built from 早 'early' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsawX* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'morning'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǎonián*
- *Say it: zǎonián*, once more
- *Say it: tā zǎonián zài wàiguó gōngzuò guo* — In his early years he worked abroad.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a script for a language, then the Mandarin for in those years long ago, then say *zǎonián* again

Before you move on

What does 早年 mean? ("One's early years; long ago".) Say it once more.

322.3 晚年 (wǎnnián) — one's later years; old age

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in those years long ago, then the Mandarin for in one's early years.

You'll want to know: 晚年

晚年 — *wǎnnián* — "one's later years; old age".

他晚年的时候回了老家 *tā wǎnnián de shíhou huí le lǎojiā* — In his later years he went back to his home town.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

晚年 (*wǎnnián*) is built from 晚 'late' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonX* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'dusk'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎnnián*
- *Say it: wǎnnián*, once more
- *Say it: tā wǎnnián de shíhou huí le lǎojiā* — In his later years he went back to his home town.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in those years long ago, then the Mandarin for in one's early years, then say *wǎnnián* again

Before you move on

What does 晚年 mean? ("One's later years; old age".) Say it once more.

322.4 一生 (yìshēng) — all one's life; a lifetime

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in one's early years, then the Mandarin for in one's later years.

You'll want to know: 一生

一生 — *yìshēng* — "all one's life; a lifetime".

他一生都在这个学校工作 *tā yìshēng dōu zài zhège xuéxiào gōngzuò* — He worked at this school all his life.

A tone change: 一 is said with a falling tone, yì, before the level tone of shēng.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

一生 (*yìshēng*) is built from 一 'one' and 生 'to live', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which calls the first the start of the numbers and glosses the second 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìshēng*
- *Say it: yìshēng*, once more
- *Say it: tā yìshēng dōu zài zhège xuéxiào gōngzuò* — He worked at this school all his life.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in one's early years, then the Mandarin for in one's later years, then say *yìshēng* again

Before you move on

What does 一生 mean? ("All one's life; a lifetime".) Say it once more.

322.5 huáiniàn — to cherish the memory of; to look back fondly on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in one's later years, then the Mandarin for all one's life.

You'll want to know: huáiniàn

huáiniàn — "to cherish the memory of; to look back fondly on".

wǒ hěn huáiniàn xiǎoshíhou de shēnghuó — I really miss my childhood days.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huáiniàn is built from *huái* and *niàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweaj* and *nemH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold to the breast' and 'to think of', and the second 'to think of'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huáiniàn*
- *Say it: huáiniàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn huáiniàn xiǎoshíhou de shēnghuó* — I really miss my childhood days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in one's later years, then the Mandarin for all one's life, then say *huáiniàn* again

Before you move on

What does huáiniàn mean? ("To cherish the memory of; to look back fondly on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 323

Decades and Eras

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a teenager, a period, a decade, ancient times and modern times.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 323: I can talk about a teenager, a period, a decade, ancient times and modern times.*

323.1 少年 (shàonián) — teenage boy; teenager

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all one's life, then the Mandarin for to look back fondly on.

You'll want to know: 少年

少年 — *shàonián* — "teenage boy; teenager".

> 他十五岁的时候是一个快乐的少年 *tā shíwǔ suì de shíhou shì yí ge kuàilè de shàonián* — At fifteen he was a happy teenager.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

少年 (*shàonián*) is built from 少 'young' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syewH* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, in this falling tone, 'young'; in its rising tone, *syewX*, it is 'few'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàonián*
- *Say it: shàonián*, once more
- *Say it: tā shíwǔ suì de shíhou shì yí ge kuàilè de shàonián* — At fifteen he was a happy teenager.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all one's life, then the Mandarin for to look back fondly on, then say *shàonián* again

Before you move on

What does 少年 mean? ("Teenage boy; teenager".) Say it once more.

323.2 时期 (shíqī) — period; phase

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look back fondly on, then the Mandarin for a teenage boy.

You'll want to know: 时期

时期 — *shíqī* — "period; phase".

那个时期当地的人都没有手机 *nàge shíqī dāngdì de rén dōu méiyǒu shǒujī* — In that period nobody there had a mobile phone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

时期 (*shíqī*) is built from 时 'a time' and 期 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyi* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to meet' and 'a limit'. Middle Chinese *gi* would regularly give a rising tone, qí; the level tone of qī is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shíqī*
- *Say it: shíqī*, once more
- *Say it: nàge shíqī dāngdì de rén dōu méiyǒu shǒujī* — In that period nobody there had a mobile phone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look back fondly on, then the Mandarin for a teenage boy, then say *shíqī* again

Before you move on

What does 时期 mean? ("Period; phase".) Say it once more.

323.3 年代 (niándài) — decade; era

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a teenage boy, then the Mandarin for a period in history.

You'll want to know: 年代

年代 — *niándài* — "decade; era".

> 他八十年代去过中国 *tā bāshí niándài qù guo Zhōngguó* — He went to China in the eighties.

The new character, in pieces: 代 — five strokes: the person piece 亻 on the left; on the right a bar rising to the right, a long stroke that slants down to the right and flicks up, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

年代 (*niándài*) is built from 年 'a year' and *dài* 'an age', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nen* and *dojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to take turns' and gives this very word as its example.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: niándài*
- *Say it: niándài*, once more
- *Say it: tā bāshí niándài qù guo Zhōngguó* — He went to China in the eighties.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a teenage boy, then the Mandarin for a period in history, then say *niándài* again

Before you move on

What does 年代 mean? ("Decade; era".) Say it once more.

323.4 代 — the person piece, then a slanting hook

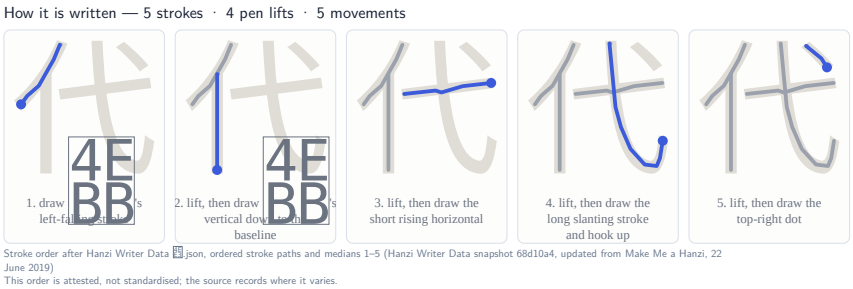
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *niándài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

信 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xìn*, *nǐ*

Script — the person piece, then a slanting hook



How 代 is written, stroke by stroke

代

Two pieces, left before right.
The left piece, 亻, two strokes, as in 你 and 信.
The right piece, three strokes. A short bar that rises a little to the right. Then a long stroke from the top, crossing the bar and slanting down to the right, flicking up at the foot. Last, a dot at the top right.
2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 代, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 代? (**Five.**) Which stroke flicks up at the foot? (**The long slanting stroke, the fourth.**) What comes last? (**A dot at the top right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 代, pinned stroke paths and medians.

323.5 古代 (gǔdài) — ancient times

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a period in history, then the Mandarin for a decade of a century.

You'll want to know: 古代

古代 — *gǔdài* — "ancient times".

我喜欢看古代的小说 *wǒ xǐhuan kàn gǔdài de xiǎoshuō* — I like reading novels from ancient times.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

古代 (*gǔdài*) is built from 古 'ancient' and 代 'an age', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *dojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'former' and the second 'to take turns'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔdài*
- *Say it: gǔdài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xǐhuan kàn gǔdài de xiǎoshuō* — I like reading novels from ancient times.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a period in history, then the Mandarin for a decade of a century, then say *gǔdài* again

Before you move on

What does 古代 mean? ("Ancient times".) Say it once more.

323.6 现代 (xiàndài) — modern times; modern

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a decade of a century, then the Mandarin for ancient times.

You'll want to know: 现代

现代 — *xiàndài* — "modern times; modern".

现代的人都有手机 *xiàndài de rén dōu yǒu shǒujī* — Everyone has a mobile phone these days.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

现代 (*xiàndài*) is built from 现 'to appear, now' and 代 'an age', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *henH* and *dojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to show'; the sense 'now' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàndài*
- *Say it: xiàndài*, once more
- *Say it: xiàndài de rén dōu yǒu shǒujī* — Everyone has a mobile phone these days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a decade of a century, then the Mandarin for ancient times, then say *xiàndài* again

Before you move on

What does 现代 mean? ("Modern times; modern".) Say it once more.

323.7 Looking back: from Letters from Far Away to Decades and Eras

Say the Mandarin for a pen pal and an envelope.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a pen pal, an envelope, a postcard, a reply to a letter, to pass on a message
- *Say it:* to return a call, confidence that it will work, an incoming call, to write to each other, phone charges
- *Say it:* to end a call, to dial a number, to get through on the phone, to bring up a subject, a voice message
- *Say it:* the history of a country, the people of long ago, an old book from long ago, age-old, a script for a language
- *Say it:* in those years long ago, in one's early years, in one's later years, all one's life, to look back fondly on

- *Say it:* a teenage boy, a period in history, a decade of a century, ancient times, modern times
- *Read it:* 信 古 代 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A pen pal? (*bǐyǒu.*) An envelope? (*xìnfēng.*) A postcard? (*míngxìnpiàn.*) A reply to a letter? (回音, *huíyīn.*) To pass on a message? (*zhuǎngào.*) To return a call? (回电, *huídiàn.*) Confidence that it will work? (信心, *xìnxīn.*) An incoming call? (来电, *láidiàn.*) To write to each other? (*tōngxìn.*) Phone charges? (*huàfèi.*) To end a call? (*guàduàn.*) To dial a number? (*bōdǎ.*) To get through on the phone? (*dǎtōng.*) To bring up a subject? (说起, *shuōqǐ.*) A voice message? (语音, *yǔyīn.*) The history of a country? (*lìshǐ.*) The people of long ago? (古人, *gǔrén.*) An old book from long ago? (古书, *gǔshū.*) Age-old? (古老, *gǔlǎo.*) A script for a language? (文字, *wénzì.*) In those years long ago? (当年, *dāngnián.*) In one's early years? (早年, *zǎonián.*) In one's later years? (晚年, *wǎnnián.*) All one's life? (一生, *yìshēng.*) To look back fondly on? (*huáiniàn.*) A teenage boy? (少年, *shàonián.*) A period in history? (时期, *shíqī.*) A decade of a century? (年代, *niándài.*) Ancient times? (古代, *gǔdài.*) Modern times? (现代, *xiàndài.*)

Chapter 324

Remembering

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say something came back to me, honour someone's memory, leave something behind and talk about an era.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 324: I can say something came back to me, honour someone's memory, leave something behind and talk about an era.*

324.1 想起 (xiǎngqǐ) — to think of; to call to mind

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ancient times, then the Mandarin for modern times.

You'll want to know: 想起

想起 — *xiǎngqǐ* — "to think of; to call to mind".

> 我突然想起了他的信 *wǒ tūrán xiǎngqǐ le tā de xìn* — I suddenly remembered his letter.

Two third tones meet in this word: xiǎng is said with a rising tone before qǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

想起 (*xiǎngqǐ*) is built from 想 'to think' and 起 'to rise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjangX* and *khiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to think' and the second 'to rise'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎngqǐ*
- *Say it: xiǎngqǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ tūrán xiǎngqǐ le tā de xìn* — I suddenly remembered his letter.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ancient times, then the Mandarin for modern times, then say *xiǎngqǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 想起 mean? ("To think of; to call to mind".) Say it once more.

324.2 jìniàn — to commemorate; to honour the memory of

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for modern times, then the Mandarin for to call to mind.

You'll want to know: jìniàn

jìniàn — "to commemorate; to honour the memory of".

měinián zhè yì tiān wǒmen dōu jìniàn tā — Every year on this day we remember him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìniàn is built from *jì* and *niàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kiX* and *nemH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, among other senses, 'to note' and 'a span of twelve years', and the second 'to think of'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìniàn*
- *Say it: jìniàn*, once more
- *Say it: měinián zhè yì tiān wǒmen dōu jìniàn tā* — Every year on this day we remember him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for modern times, then the Mandarin for to call to mind, then say *jìniàn* again

Before you move on

What does jìniàn mean? ("To commemorate; to honour the memory of".) Say it once more.

324.3 liúxià — to leave behind

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to call to mind, then the Mandarin for to honour the memory of.

You'll want to know: liúxià

liúxià — "to leave behind".

yéye gěi wǒmen liúxià le yì běn gǔshū — Grandpa left us an old book.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúxià is built from *liú* 'to stay' and 下 'down', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *haeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stay' and 'to stop' and the second 'below'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúxià*
- *Say it: liúxià*, once more
- *Say it: yéye gěi wǒmen liúxià le yì běn gǔshū* — Grandpa left us an old book.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to call to mind, then the Mandarin for to honour the memory of, then say *liúxià* again

Before you move on

What does liúxià mean? ("To leave behind".) Say it once more.

324.4 时代 (shídài) — era; age

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to honour the memory of, then the Mandarin for to leave behind for others.

You'll want to know: 时代

时代 — *shídài* — "era; age".

现在是手机的时代 *xiànzài shì shǒujī de shídài* — This is the age of the mobile phone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

时代 (*shídài*) is built from 时 'a time' and 代 'an age', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyi* and *dojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first with another word for a time and the second 'to take turns'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shídài*
- *Say it: shídài*, once more
- *Say it: xiànzài shì shǒujī de shídài* — This is the age of the mobile phone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to honour the memory of, then the Mandarin for to leave behind for others, then say *shídài* again

Before you move on

What does 时代 mean? ("Era; age".) Say it once more.

324.5 yìnxiàng — impression

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leave behind for others, then the Mandarin for an age in history.

You'll want to know: yìnxiàng

yìnxiàng — "impression".

wǒ duì nàge dìfang de yìnxiàng hěn hǎo — That place made a very good impression on me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìnxiàng is built from *yìn* 'a seal' and *xiàng* 'an image', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jinH* and *zjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a seal' and describes the second

as the long-nosed beast of the south. The sense 'an image' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìnxiàng*
- *Say it: yìnxiàng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ duì nàge dìfang de yìnxiàng hěn hǎo* — That place made a very good impression on me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leave behind for others, then the Mandarin for an age in history, then say *yìnxiàng* again

Before you move on

What does yìnxiàng mean? ("Impression".) Say it once more.

Chapter 325

Gone but Remembered

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give an account of the past, say someone has died, and talk about descendants, generations and missing someone.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 325: I can give an account of the past, say someone has died, and talk about descendants, generations and missing someone.*

325.1 jiǎngshù — to tell about; to give an account of

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an age in history, then the Mandarin for an impression left on you.

You'll want to know: jiǎngshù

jiǎngshù — "to tell about; to give an account of".

> *tā gěi wǒmen jiǎngshù le nàge shíqī de shēnghuó* — He told us what life was like in that period.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎngshù is built from *jiǎng* and *shù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngX* and *zywit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tell' and 'to discuss' and the second 'to set forth in writing'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎngshù*
- *Say it: jiǎngshù*, once more
- *Say it: tā gěi wǒmen jiǎngshù le nàge shíqī de shēnghuó* — He told us what life was like in that period.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an age in history, then the Mandarin for an impression left on you, then say *jiǎngshù* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎngshù mean? ("To tell about; to give an account of".) Say it once more.

325.2 去世 (qùshì) — to pass away

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an impression left on you, then the Mandarin for to give an account of.

You'll want to know: 去世

去世 — *qùshì* — "to pass away".

他的外公去年去世了 *tā de wàigōng qùnián qùshì le* — His grandfather died last year.

The new character, in pieces: 世 — five strokes: a long bar; two verticals through it; a short bar joining their feet; then a stroke down the left that turns right along the bottom. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

去世 (*qùshì*) is built from 去 'to leave' and 世 'the world', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khjoH* and *syejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to leave' and the second 'a generation'. The sense 'the world' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qùshì*
- *Say it: qùshì*, once more
- *Say it: tā de wàigōng qùnián qùshì le* — His grandfather died last year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an impression left on you, then the Mandarin for to give an account of, then say *qùshì* again

Before you move on

What does 去世 mean? ("To pass away".) Say it once more.

325.3 世 — a long bar and two verticals

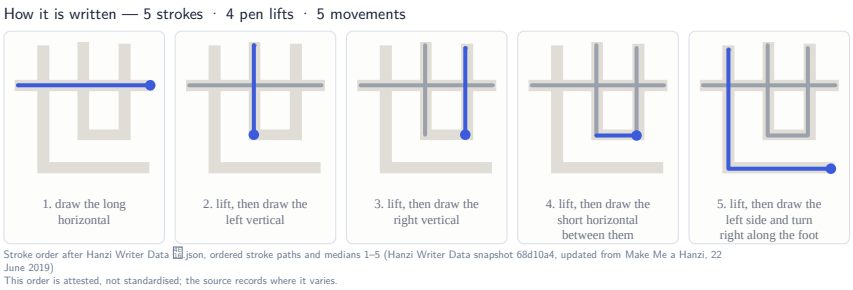
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qùshì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  十 去

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shí*, *qù*

Script — a long bar and two verticals



How 世 is written, stroke by stroke

世

One piece, five strokes.

First the long bar, from left to right.

Then two verticals through it, the left one first, each longer above the bar than below it.

Then a short bar joining the feet of the two verticals.

Last, the turning stroke: down the left side, then right along the bottom, under everything.

1 + 2 + 1 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 世, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 世? (**Five**.) What comes after the long bar? (**Two verticals through it**.) What is the last stroke? (**One that runs down the left and turns right along the bottom**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 世, pinned stroke paths and medians.

325.4 后代 (hòudài) — descendants; later generations

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give an account of, then the Mandarin for to pass away.

You'll want to know: 后代

后代 — *hòudài* — "descendants; later generations".

他的后代现在都在国外 *tā de hòudài xiànzài dōu zài guówài* — His descendants are all abroad now.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

后代 (*hòudài*) is built from 后 'after' and 代 'a generation', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *dojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'before and after' and the second 'to take turns'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòudài*
- *Say it: hòudài*, once more
- *Say it: tā de hòudài xiànzài dōu zài guówài* — His descendants are all abroad now.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give an account of, then the Mandarin for to pass away, then say *hòudài* again

Before you move on

What does 后代 mean? ("Descendants; later generations".) Say it once more.

325.5 世代 (shìdài) — for generations

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pass away, then the Mandarin for one's descendants.

You'll want to know: 世代

世代 — *shìdài* — "for generations".

他们家世代都是医生 *tāmen jiā shìdài dōu shì yīshēng* — Their family have been doctors for generations.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

世代 (*shìdài*) is built from 世 'a generation' and 代 'an age', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syejH* and *dojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with the second: a generation.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìdài*
- *Say it: shìdài*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen jiā shìdài dōu shì yīshēng* — Their family have been doctors for generations.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pass away, then the Mandarin for one's descendants, then say *shìdài* again

Before you move on

What does 世代 mean? ("For generations".) Say it once more.

325.6 xiǎngniàn — to miss someone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's descendants, then the Mandarin for for generations on end.

You'll want to know: xiǎngniàn

xiǎngniàn — "to miss someone".

> *wàigōng qùshì yǐhòu wǒ hěn xiǎngniàn tā* — After my grandpa died I missed him very much.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiǎngniàn is built from 想 'to think' and *niàn* 'to think of', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjangX* and *nemH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses both 'to think'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎngniàn*
- *Say it: xiǎngniàn*, once more
- *Say it: wàigōng qùshì yǐhòu wǒ hěn xiǎngniàn tā* — After my grandpa died I missed him very much.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's descendants, then the Mandarin for for generations on end, then say *xiǎngniàn* again

Before you move on

What does xiǎngniàn mean? ("To miss someone".) Say it once more.

Chapter 326

Around the World

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about countries, the world, the outside world, founding something and old civilizations.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 326: I can talk about countries, the world, the outside world, founding something and old civilizations.*

326.1 国家 (guójiā) — country; nation

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for for generations on end, then the Mandarin for to miss someone dearly.

You'll want to know: 国家

国家 — *guójiā* — "country; nation".

> 我去过三个国家 *wǒ qù guo sān ge guójiā* — I've been to three countries.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

国家 (*guójiā*) is built from 国 'a state' and 家 'a home', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a realm' and the second 'a dwelling'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guójiā*
- *Say it: guójiā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qù guo sān ge guójiā* — I've been to three countries.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for for generations on end, then the Mandarin for to miss someone dearly, then say *guójiā* again

Before you move on

What does 国家 mean? ("Country; nation".) Say it once more.

326.2 世界 (shìjiè) — world

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to miss someone dearly, then the Mandarin for a nation with its own government.

You'll want to know: 世界

世界 — *shìjiè* — "world".

我想去看世界 *wǒ xiǎng qù kàn shìjiè* — I want to go and see the world.

The new character, in pieces: 界 — nine strokes: on top a field, a box of five strokes cut into four; under it 人 opened wide, and under that a short stroke falling to the left and a vertical. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

世界 (*shìjiè*) is built from 世 'a generation' and *jiè* 'a boundary', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syejH* and *keajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a generation' and the second 'a border' and 'an edge'. The sense 'the world' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìjiè*
- *Say it: shìjiè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng qù kàn shìjiè* — I want to go and see the world.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to miss someone dearly, then the Mandarin for a nation with its own government, then say *shìjiè* again

Before you move on

What does 世界 mean? ("World".) Say it once more.

326.3 界 — a field over 人

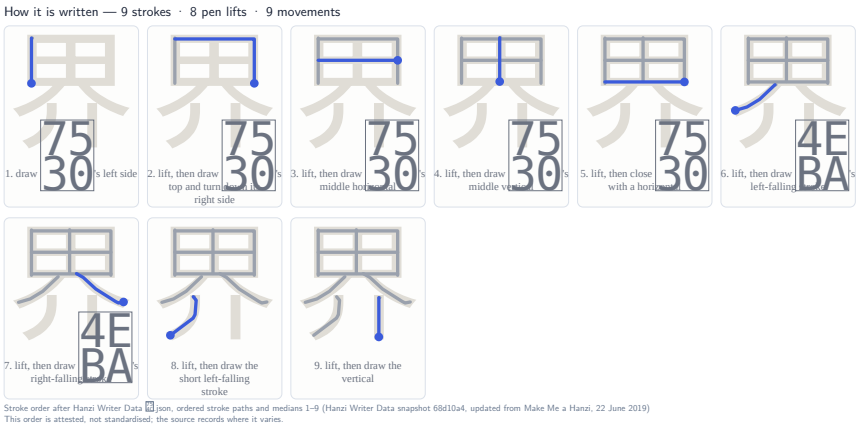
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shìjiè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

人 世

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *shì*

Script — a field over 人



How 界 is written, stroke by stroke

界

Two pieces, top to bottom.

The top piece, a field, five strokes. A short vertical on the left. A bar that runs right and turns down. A bar across the middle, then a vertical down the middle. Then the bar that closes the foot.

The bottom piece, four strokes. First 人, opened wide: a long stroke falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the right. Under them, a short stroke that falls to the left, and a vertical on the right.

5 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 界, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 界? (**Nine**.) What is on top? (**A field, five strokes**.) What opens the bottom piece? (人.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 界, pinned stroke paths and medians.

326.4 外界 (wàijiè) — the outside world

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a nation with its own government, then the Mandarin for the whole wide world.

You'll want to know: 外界

外界 — *wàijiè* — "the outside world".

外界都很关心他的病 *wàijiè dōu hěn guānxīn tā de bìng* — People everywhere are concerned about his illness.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

外界 (*wàijiè*) is built from 外 'outside' and 界 'a boundary', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *keajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'outside' and 'far' and the second 'a border'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàijiè*
- *Say it: wàijiè*, once more
- *Say it: wàijiè dōu hěn guānxīn tā de bìng* — People everywhere are concerned about his illness.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a nation with its own government, then the Mandarin for the whole wide world, then say *wàijiè* again

Before you move on

What does 外界 mean? ("The outside world".) Say it once more.

326.5 jiànlì — to found; to set up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the whole wide world, then the Mandarin for the outside world.

You'll want to know: jiànlì

jiànlì — "to found; to set up".

> *tāmen yìbǎi nián qián jiànlì le zhège xuéxiào* — They founded this school a hundred years ago.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiànlì is built from *jiàn* and *lì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjonH* and *lip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to set up' and 'to plant', and the second 'to stand' and 'to complete'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànlì*
- *Say it: jiànlì*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen yìbǎi nián qián jiànlì le zhège xuéxiào* — They founded this school a hundred years ago.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the whole wide world, then the Mandarin for the outside world, then say *jiànlì* again

Before you move on

What does jiànlì mean? ("To found; to set up".) Say it once more.

326.6 文明 (wénmíng) — civilization

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the outside world, then the Mandarin for to found something new.

You'll want to know: 文明

文明 — *wénmíng* — "civilization".

> 中国有很古老的文明 *Zhōngguó yǒu hěn gǔlǎo de wénmíng* — China has a very ancient civilization.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

文明 (*wénmíng*) is built from 文 'writing' and 明 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjun* and *mjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'writing' and 'beautiful' and the second 'light'. The sense 'civilization' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wénmíng*
- *Say it: wénmíng*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngguó yǒu hěn gǔlǎo de wénmíng* — China has a very ancient civilization.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the outside world, then the Mandarin for to found something new, then say *wénmíng* again

Before you move on

What does 文明 mean? ("Civilization".) Say it once more.

Chapter 327

Heroes and Emperors

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about famous people, heroes and emperors, and say two countries went to war.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 327: I can talk about famous people, heroes and emperors, and say two countries went to war.*

327.1 名人 (míngrén) — famous person; well-known figure

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to found something new, then the Mandarin for an ancient civilization.

You'll want to know: 名人

名人 — *míngrén* — "famous person; well-known figure".

> 他是一个世界名人 *tā shì yí ge shìjiè míngrén* — He's famous all over the world.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

名人 (*míngrén*) is built from 名 'a name' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjieng* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a name'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngrén*
- *Say it: míngrén*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì yí ge shìjiè míngrén* — He's famous all over the world.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to found something new, then the Mandarin for an ancient civilization, then say *míngrén* again

Before you move on

What does 名人 mean? ("Famous person; well-known figure".) Say it once more.

327.2 yīngxióng — hero

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an ancient civilization, then the Mandarin for a famous person.

You'll want to know: yīngxióng

yīngxióng — "hero".

wǒ bàba shì wǒ de yīngxióng — My dad is my hero.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīngxióng is built from *yīng* and *xióng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jaeng* and *hjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a flower' and 'outstanding', and the second 'male' as against female.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīngxióng*
- *Say it: yīngxióng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba shì wǒ de yīngxióng* — My dad is my hero.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an ancient civilization, then the Mandarin for a famous person, then say *yīngxióng* again

Before you move on

What does yīngxióng mean? ("Hero".) Say it once more.

327.3 huángdì — emperor

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a famous person, then the Mandarin for a hero.

You'll want to know: huángdì

huángdì — "emperor".

tā shí suì de shíhou dāng le huángdì — He became emperor when he was ten.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huángdì is built from *huáng* and *dì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwang* and *tejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a sovereign' and 'great', and calls the second the title of one who rules all under heaven.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huángdì*
- *Say it: huángdì*, once more
- *Say it: tā shí suì de shíhou dāng le huángdì* — He became emperor when he was ten.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a famous person, then the Mandarin for a hero, then say *huángdì* again

Before you move on

What does huángdì mean? ("Emperor".) Say it once more.

327.4 dǎzhàng — to fight a war; to go into battle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hero, then the Mandarin for an emperor.

You'll want to know: dǎzhàng

dǎzhàng — "to fight a war; to go into battle".

gǔdài de shíhou zhè liǎng ge guójiā chángcháng dǎzhàng — In ancient times these two countries were often at war.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎzhàng is built from 打 'to strike' and *zhàng* 'weapons', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *drjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hit' and the second 'arms'. Middle Chinese *taengX* would not regularly give dǎ.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎzhàng*
- *Say it: dǎzhàng*, once more
- *Say it: gǔdài de shíhou zhè liǎng ge guójiā chángcháng dǎzhàng* — In ancient times these two countries were often at war.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hero, then the Mandarin for an emperor, then say *dǎzhàng* again

Before you move on

What does dǎzhàng mean? ("To fight a war; to go into battle".) Say it once more.

327.5 zhànzhēng — war

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an emperor, then the Mandarin for to go into battle.

You'll want to know: zhànzhēng

zhànzhēng — "war".

> *zhànzhēng de shíhou yéye hái shì yí ge shàonián* — During the war my grandpa was still a teenager.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhànzhēng is built from *zhàn* and *zhēng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyenH* and *tsreang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to fear' and the second 'to compete'. The sense 'to fight' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhànzhēng*
- *Say it: zhànzhēng*, once more
- *Say it: zhànzhēng de shíhou yéye hái shì yí ge shàonián* — During the war my grandpa was still a teenager.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an emperor, then the Mandarin for to go into battle, then say *zhànzhēng* again

Before you move on

What does zhànzhēng mean? ("War".) Say it once more.

Chapter 328

A Legend

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about myths and legends, say a story was handed down, name a dragon and carry messages.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 328: I can talk about myths and legends, say a story was handed down, name a dragon and carry messages.*

328.1 shénhuà — myth

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go into battle, then the Mandarin for a war between countries.

You'll want to know: shénhuà

shénhuà — "myth".

> *wǒ xiǎoshíhou tīng guo yí ge shénhuà* — When I was little I heard a myth.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shénhuà is built from *shén* 'a god' and 话 'talk', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zyin* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a spirit' and the second 'talk'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shénhuà*
- *Say it: shénhuà*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎoshíhou tīng guo yí ge shénhuà* — When I was little I heard a myth.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go into battle, then the Mandarin for a war between countries, then say *shénhuà* again

Before you move on

What does shénhuà mean? ("Myth".) Say it once more.

328.2 传说 (chuánshuō) — legend; folk tale

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a war between countries, then the Mandarin for a myth about the gods.

You'll want to know: 传说

传说 — *chuánshuō* — "legend; folk tale".

zhège dìfang yǒu yí ge gǔlǎo de chuánshuō — This place has an old legend.

The new character, in pieces: 传 — six strokes: the person piece 亻 on the left; on the right two bars, a stroke that runs down, turns right and sweeps down to the left, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

传说 (*chuánshuō*) is built from 传 'to pass on' and 说 'to tell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjwen* and *sywet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn over, to pass along' and the second 'to tell'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuánshuō*
- *Say it: chuánshuō*, once more
- *Say it: zhège dìfang yǒu yí ge gǔlǎo de chuánshuō* — This place has an old legend.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a war between countries, then the Mandarin for a myth about the gods, then say *chuánshuō* again

Before you move on

What does 传说 mean? ("Legend; folk tale".) Say it once more.

328.3 传 — the person piece, then two bars and a turning sweep

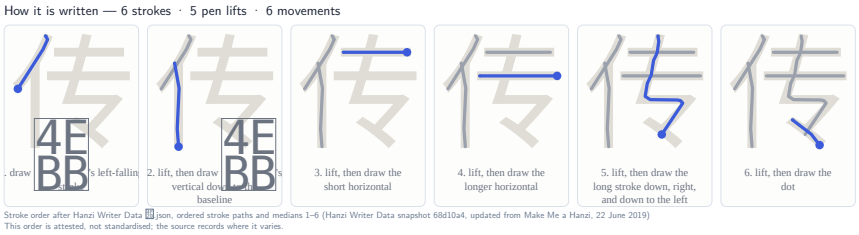
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chuánshuō* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  代 说

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dài*, *shuō*

Script — the person piece, then two bars and a turning sweep



How 传 is written, stroke by stroke

传

Two pieces, left before right.
The left piece, 亻, two strokes, as in 代.
The right piece, four strokes. A short bar, then a longer bar under it. Then one stroke that starts above the bars, runs down through them, turns right, and sweeps down to the left. Last, a dot at the foot.
2 + 4 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 传, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 传? (**Six.**) What is the left piece? (亻.) What comes last? (**A dot at the foot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 传, pinned stroke paths and medians.

328.4 liúchuán — to be handed down; to spread

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a myth about the gods, then the Mandarin for an old folk tale.

You'll want to know: liúchuán

liúchuán — "to be handed down; to spread".

> *zhège chuánshuō liúchuán le yìqiān nián* — This legend has been handed down for a thousand years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúchuán is built from *liú* 'to flow' and 传 'to pass on', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *drjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'water moving'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúchuán*
- *Say it: liúchuán*, once more
- *Say it: zhège chuánshuō liúchuán le yìqiān nián* — This legend has been handed down for a thousand years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a myth about the gods, then the Mandarin for an old folk tale, then say *liúchuán* again

Before you move on

What does liúchuán mean? ("To be handed down; to spread".) Say it once more.

328.5 lóng — dragon

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an old folk tale, then the Mandarin for to be handed down over time.

You'll want to know: lóng

lóng — "dragon".

> *chuánshuō lǐ lóng zhù zài shuǐ lǐ* — In legends, dragons live in water.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lóng is inherited from Middle Chinese *ljowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which calls it the chief of the scaly creatures and quotes an older book: clouds follow the dragon.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: lóng*
- *Say it: lóng*, once more
- *Say it: chuánshuō lǐ lóng zhù zài shuǐ lǐ* — In legends, dragons live in water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an old folk tale, then the Mandarin for to be handed down over time, then say *lóng* again

Before you move on

What does lóng mean? ("Dragon".) Say it once more.

328.6 传话 (chuánhuà) — to carry messages between people

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be handed down over time, then the Mandarin for a dragon.

You'll want to know: 传话

传话 — *chuánhuà* — "to carry messages between people".

> 他们两个人不说话他在中间传话 *tāmen liǎng ge rén bù shuōhuà tā zài zhōngjiān chuánhuà* — Those two aren't speaking, so he carries messages between them.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

传话 (*chuánhuà*) is built from 传 'to pass on' and 话 'words', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjwen* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'talk'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuánhuà*
- *Say it: chuánhuà*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen liǎng ge rén bù shuōhuà tā zài zhōngjiān chuánhuà* — Those two aren't speaking, so he carries messages between them.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be handed down over time, then the Mandarin for a dragon, then say *chuánhuà* again

Before you move on

What does 传话 mean? ("To carry messages between people".) Say it once more.

Chapter 329

Once upon a Time

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about fairy tales, a princess and a fairy, say someone vanished, and talk about how a story ends.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 329: I can talk about fairy tales, a princess and a fairy, say someone vanished, and talk about how a story ends.*

329.1 tónghuà — fairy tale

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a dragon, then the Mandarin for to carry messages between people.

You'll want to know: tónghuà

tónghuà — "fairy tale".

> *xiǎoshíhou māma měitiān wǎnshang gěi wǒ dú tónghuà* — When I was little, my mum read me a fairy tale every evening.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tónghuà is built from *tóng* 'a child' and 话 'talk', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwng* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says of the first that it means a child not yet married.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tónghuà*
- *Say it: tónghuà*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou māma měitiān wǎnshang gěi wǒ dú tónghuà* — When I was little, my mum read me a fairy tale every evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a dragon, then the Mandarin for to carry messages between people, then say *tónghuà* again

Before you move on

What does tónghuà mean? ("Fairy tale".) Say it once more.

329.2 gōngzhǔ — princess

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to carry messages between people, then the Mandarin for a fairy tale for children.

You'll want to know: gōngzhǔ

gōngzhǔ — "princess".

cóngqián yǒu yí ge hěn piàoliang de gōngzhǔ — Once upon a time there was a very beautiful princess.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngzhǔ is built from 公 and *zhǔ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *tsyuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a father' and 'an official' and the second 'to be in charge' and 'a lord'. How the pair came to mean a princess is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngzhǔ*
- *Say it: gōngzhǔ*, once more
- *Say it: cóngqián yǒu yí ge hěn piàoliang de gōngzhǔ* — Once upon a time there was a very beautiful princess.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to carry messages between people, then the Mandarin for a fairy tale for children, then say *gōngzhǔ* again

Before you move on

What does gōngzhǔ mean? ("Princess".) Say it once more.

329.3 xiānnǚ — fairy; heavenly maiden

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a fairy tale for children, then the Mandarin for a princess in a story.

You'll want to know: xiānnǚ

xiānnǚ — "fairy; heavenly maiden".

chuánshuō lǐ yǒu qī ge xiānnǚ — In the legend there are seven fairies.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiānnǚ is built from *xiān* 'an immortal' and 女 'a woman', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjen* and *nrjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says of the first that one who grows old and does not die is called so.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiānnǚ*
- *Say it: xiānnǚ*, once more
- *Say it: chuánshuō lǐ yǒu qī ge xiānnǚ* — In the legend there are seven fairies.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a fairy tale for children, then the Mandarin for a princess in a story, then say *xiānnǚ* again

Before you move on

What does xiānnǚ mean? ("Fairy; heavenly maiden".) Say it once more.

329.4 xiāoshī — to disappear; to vanish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a princess in a story, then the Mandarin for a heavenly maiden.

You'll want to know: xiāoshī

xiāoshī — "to disappear; to vanish".

dì'èr tiān zǎoshang nàge xiānnǚ tūrán xiāoshī le — The next morning the fairy suddenly vanished.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāoshī is built from *xiāo* and *shī*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjew* and *syit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to die out' and 'to be used up', and the second 'to err' and 'to let go'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāoshī*
- *Say it: xiāoshī*, once more
- *Say it: dì'èr tiān zǎoshang nàge xiānnǚ tūrán xiāoshī le* — The next morning the fairy suddenly vanished.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a princess in a story, then the Mandarin for a heavenly maiden, then say *xiāoshī* again

Before you move on

What does xiāoshī mean? ("To disappear; to vanish".) Say it once more.

329.5 jiéjú — ending

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a heavenly maiden, then the Mandarin for to vanish without a trace.

You'll want to know: jiéjú

jiéjú — "ending".

kàn le jiéjú yǐhòu wǒ kū le — I cried after reading the ending.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiéjú is built from *jié* 'to tie' and *jú*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ket* and *gjowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tie' and the second 'an office' and 'a portion'. How the pair came to mean an ending is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiéjú*
- *Say it: jiéjú*, once more
- *Say it: kàn le jiéjú yǐhòu wǒ kū le* — I cried after reading the ending.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a heavenly maiden, then the Mandarin for to vanish without a trace, then say *jiéjú* again

Before you move on

What does jiéjú mean? ("Ending".) Say it once more.

329.6 Looking back: from Remembering to Once upon a Time

Say the Mandarin for to call to mind and to honour the memory of.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to call to mind, to honour the memory of, to leave behind for others, an age in history, an impression left on you
- *Say it:* to give an account of, to pass away, one's descendants, for generations on end, to miss someone dearly
- *Say it:* a nation with its own government, the whole wide world, the outside world, to found something new, an ancient civilization
- *Say it:* a famous person, a hero, an emperor, to go into battle, a war between countries
- *Say it:* a myth about the gods, an old folk tale, to be handed down over time, a dragon, to carry messages between people

- *Say it:* a fairy tale for children, a princess in a story, a heavenly maiden, to vanish without a trace, the ending of a story
- *Read it:* 世 界 传 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To call to mind? (想起, *xiǎngqǐ.*) To honour the memory of? (*jìniàn.*) To leave behind for others? (*liúxià.*) An age in history? (时代, *shídài.*) An impression left on you? (*yìnxiàng.*) To give an account of? (*jiǎngshù.*) To pass away? (去世, *qùshì.*) One's descendants? (后代, *hòudài.*) For generations on end? (世代, *shìdài.*) To miss someone dearly? (*xiǎngniàn.*) A nation with its own government? (国家, *guójiā.*) The whole wide world? (世界, *shìjiè.*) The outside world? (外界, *wàijiè.*) To found something new? (*jiànlì.*) An ancient civilization? (文明, *wénmíng.*) A famous person? (名人, *míngrén.*) A hero? (*yīngxióng.*) An emperor? (*huángdì.*) To go into battle? (*dǎzhàng.*) A war between countries? (*zhànzhēng.*) A myth about the gods? (*shénhuà.*) An old folk tale? (传说, *chuánshuō.*) To be handed down over time? (*liúchuán.*) A dragon? (*lóng.*) To carry messages between people? (传话, *chuánhuà.*) A fairy tale for children? (*tónghuà.*) A princess in a story? (*gōngzhǔ.*) A heavenly maiden? (*xiānnǚ.*) To vanish without a trace? (*xiāoshī.*) The ending of a story? (*jiéjú.*)

Chapter 330

The King's Son

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a king, a queen, a prince and a kingdom, and say someone took over from a parent.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 330: I can talk about a king, a queen, a prince and a kingdom, and say someone took over from a parent.*

330.1 jìchéng — to inherit; to take over (from a parent)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to vanish without a trace, then the Mandarin for the ending of a story.

You'll want to know: jìchéng

jìchéng — "to inherit; to take over (from a parent)".

> *tā èrshí suì de shíhou jìchéng le tā bàba de shūdiàn* — When he was twenty he took over his father's bookshop.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìchéng is built from *jì* and *chéng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kejH* and *dzying* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to carry on' and the second 'to receive'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìchéng*
- *Say it: jìchéng*, once more
- *Say it: tā èrshí suì de shíhou jìchéng le tā bàba de shūdiàn* — When he was twenty he took over his father's bookshop.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to vanish without a trace, then the Mandarin for the ending of a story, then say *jìchéng* again

Before you move on

What does jìchéng mean? ("To inherit; to take over (from a parent)".) Say it once more.

330.2 王子 (wángzǐ) — prince

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the ending of a story, then the Mandarin for to inherit the family business.

You'll want to know: 王子

王子 — *wángzǐ* — "prince".

王子一个人走了很长的路 *wángzǐ yí ge rén zǒu le hěn cháng de lù* — The prince walked a long way on his own.

The new character, in pieces: 王 — four strokes: three bars, the middle one the shortest and the bottom one the longest, with a vertical through the middle. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

王子 (*wángzǐ*) is built from 王 'a king' and 子 'a son', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwang* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'great' and 'a ruler' and the second 'a child'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wángzǐ*
- *Say it: wángzǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wángzǐ yí ge rén zǒu le hěn cháng de lù* — The prince walked a long way on his own.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the ending of a story, then the Mandarin for to inherit the family business, then say *wángzǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 王子 mean? ("Prince".) Say it once more.

330.3 王 — two bars, a vertical, a long bar

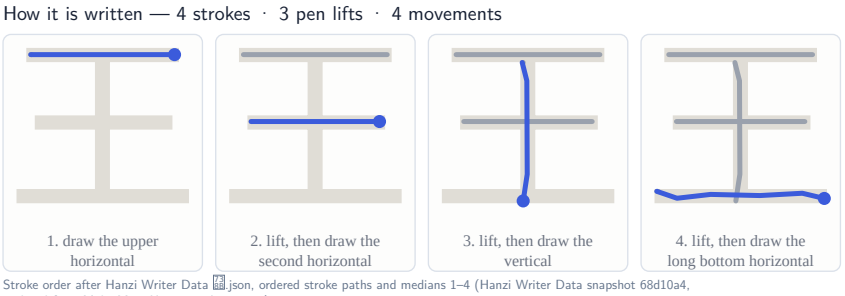
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wángzǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

三 国

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *sān*, *guó*

Script — two bars, a vertical, a long bar



How 王 is written, stroke by stroke

王

One piece, four strokes.

Two bars first, the top one, then a shorter one in the middle.

Then the vertical, from the top bar down through the middle one to the foot.

Last, the longest bar, along the foot, closing the vertical.

2 + 1 + 1 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 王, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 王? (**Four**.) Which bar is the longest? (**The last, at the foot**.) Does the vertical come before or after the last bar? (**Before**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 王, pinned stroke paths and medians.

330.4 国王 (guówáng) — king

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to inherit the family business, then the Mandarin for a prince.

You'll want to know: 国王

国王 — *guówáng* — "king".

> 传说里有一个很老的国王 *chuánshuō lǐ yǒu yí ge hěn lǎo de guówáng* — In the legend there is a very old king.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

国王 (*guówáng*) is built from 国 'a state' and 王 'a ruler', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *hjwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'great' and 'a ruler'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guówáng*
- *Say it: guówáng*, once more
- *Say it: chuánshuō lǐ yǒu yí ge hěn lǎo de guówáng* — In the legend there is a very old king.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to inherit the family business, then the Mandarin for a prince, then say *guówáng* again

Before you move on

What does 国王 mean? ("King".) Say it once more.

330.5 王后 (wánghòu) — queen (a king's wife)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a prince, then the Mandarin for a king in a story.

You'll want to know: 王后

王后 — *wánghòu* — "queen (a king's wife)".

> 国王和王后有一个女儿 *guówáng hé wánghòu yǒu yí ge nǚ'ér* — The king and queen had a daughter.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

王后 (*wánghòu*) is built from 王 'a king' and *hòu* 'a queen', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwang* and *huwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the second under both *huwX* and *huwH*, 'a sovereign', and under *huwH* also 'an empress'. This *hòu* is a different word from the 后 of 后来, whose older form the dictionary lists under *huwX*, 'before and after'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wánghòu*
- *Say it: wánghòu*, once more
- *Say it: guówáng hé wánghòu yǒu yí ge nǚ'ér* — The king and queen had a daughter.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a prince, then the Mandarin for a king in a story, then say *wánghòu* again

Before you move on

What does 王后 mean? ("Queen (a king's wife)".) Say it once more.

330.6 王国 (wángguó) — kingdom

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a king in a story, then the Mandarin for a king's wife.

You'll want to know: 王国

王国 — *wángguó* — "kingdom".

王子离开了他的王国去看外边的世界 *wángzǐ líkāi le tā de wángguó qù kàn wàibian de shìjiè* — The prince left his kingdom to go and see the world outside.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

王国 (*wángguó*) is built from 王 'a king' and 国 'a state', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwang* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a realm'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wángguó*
- *Say it: wángguó*, once more
- *Say it: wángzǐ líkāi le tā de wángguó qù kàn wàibian de shìjiè* — The prince left his kingdom to go and see the world outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a king in a story, then the Mandarin for a king's wife, then say *wángguó* again

Before you move on

What does 王国 mean? ("Kingdom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 331

Monsters and Treasure

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about monsters, immortals, magic and treasure, and say people hid.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 331: I can talk about monsters, immortals, magic and treasure, and say people hid.*

331.1 yāoguài — monster; demon

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a king's wife, then the Mandarin for a kingdom ruled by a king.

You'll want to know: yāoguài

yāoguài — "monster; demon".

> *chuánshuō shān lǐ yǒu yí ge yāoguài* — Legend says there's a monster in the mountains.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yāoguài is built from *yāo* and *guài* 'strange', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jew* and *kweajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'bewitching' and the second 'strange'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yāoguài*
- *Say it: yāoguài*, once more
- *Say it: chuánshuō shān lǐ yǒu yí ge yāoguài* — Legend says there's a monster in the mountains.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a king's wife, then the Mandarin for a kingdom ruled by a king, then say *yāoguài* again

Before you move on

What does yāoguài mean? ("Monster; demon".) Say it once more.

331.2 shénxiān — immortal; supernatural being

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a kingdom ruled by a king, then the Mandarin for a monster in a story.

You'll want to know: shénxiān

shénxiān — "immortal; supernatural being".

zuìhòu yí ge shénxiān bāng le tā — In the end an immortal helped him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shénxiān is built from *shén* 'a god' and *xiān* 'an immortal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zyin* and *sjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a spirit' and says of the second that one who grows old and does not die is called so.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shénxiān*
- *Say it: shénxiān*, once more
- *Say it: zuìhòu yí ge shénxiān bāng le tā* — In the end an immortal helped him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a kingdom ruled by a king, then the Mandarin for a monster in a story, then say *shénxiān* again

Before you move on

What does shénxiān mean? ("Immortal; supernatural being".) Say it once more.

331.3 mófǎ — magic

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a monster in a story, then the Mandarin for a Daoist immortal.

You'll want to know: mófǎ

mófǎ — "magic".

nàge shénxiān huì mófǎ — That immortal can do magic.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mófǎ is built from *mó* 'a demon' and *fǎ* 'a method', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ma* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a demon' and the second 'a rule' and 'a norm'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: mófǎ*
- *Say it: mófǎ*, once more
- *Say it: nàge shénxiān huì mófǎ* — That immortal can do magic.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a monster in a story, then the Mandarin for a Daoist immortal, then say *mófǎ* again

Before you move on

What does mófǎ mean? ("Magic".) Say it once more.

331.4 bǎowù — treasure

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a Daoist immortal, then the Mandarin for magic in a fairy tale.

You'll want to know: bǎowù

bǎowù — "treasure".

tā zài shān lǐ zhǎodào le yí ge bǎowù — He found a treasure in the mountains.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎowù is built from *bǎo* 'precious' and *wù* 'a thing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *mjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a treasure' and the second 'all things'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎowù*
- *Say it: bǎowù*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài shān lǐ zhǎodào le yí ge bǎowù* — He found a treasure in the mountains.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a Daoist immortal, then the Mandarin for magic in a fairy tale, then say *bǎowù* again

Before you move on

What does bǎowù mean? ("Treasure".) Say it once more.

331.5 cáng — to hide

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for magic in a fairy tale, then the Mandarin for a precious treasure.

You'll want to know: cáng

cáng — "to hide".

> *yāoguài lái de shíhou tāmen dōu cáng zài mén hòubian* — When the monster came, they all hid behind the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cáng is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to conceal' and 'to keep out of sight'. The dictionary also lists *dzangH*, 'a storehouse', a different word.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: cáng*
- *Say it: cáng*, once more
- *Say it: yāoguài lái de shíhou tāmen dōu cáng zài mén hòubian* — When the monster came, they all hid behind the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for magic in a fairy tale, then the Mandarin for a precious treasure, then say *cáng* again

Before you move on

What does cáng mean? ("To hide".) Say it once more.

Chapter 332

Ghost Stories

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about courage, ghosts and a haunted house, curse my luck and talk about the world of the living.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 332: I can talk about courage, ghosts and a haunted house, curse my luck and talk about the world of the living.*

332.1 dǎnzi — courage; nerve

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a precious treasure, then the Mandarin for to hide away.

You'll want to know: dǎnzi

dǎnzi — "courage; nerve".

> *xiǎoshíhou wǒ de dǎnzi hěn xiǎo* — When I was little I was very timid.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎnzi is built from *dǎn* 'the gall' and 子, here a light noun ending, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tamX* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which pairs the first with the liver.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎnzi*
- *Say it: dǎnzi*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou wǒ de dǎnzi hěn xiǎo* — When I was little I was very timid.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a precious treasure, then the Mandarin for to hide away, then say *dǎnzi* again

Before you move on

What does dǎnzi mean? ("Courage; nerve".) Say it once more.

332.2 鬼 (guǐ) — ghost

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hide away, then the Mandarin for the nerve to face danger.

You'll want to know: 鬼

鬼 — *guǐ* — "ghost".

那个房子里有鬼 *nàge fángzi lǐ yǒu guǐ* — There's a ghost in that house.

The new character, in pieces: 鬼 — nine strokes: a short stroke falling left over a box with a bar inside; from the box two long strokes, one falling to the left, one bending right along the foot and hooking up; and on the right a small turning stroke and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

鬼 (*guǐ*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjw+jX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the word by one of like sound, 'to return home'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǐ*
- *Say it: guǐ*, once more
- *Say it: nàge fángzi lǐ yǒu guǐ* — There's a ghost in that house.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hide away, then the Mandarin for the nerve to face danger, then say *guǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 鬼 mean? ("Ghost".) Say it once more.

332.3 鬼 — a box with long legs

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *guǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 儿

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *ér*

Script — a box with long legs

How 鬼 *is written, stroke by stroke*

鬼

Three pieces: the box, then the legs, then the small piece on the right.

The box, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left on top. Then a short vertical on the left, a bar that runs right and turns down, a bar across the middle, and the bar that closes the foot.

The legs, two strokes. A long stroke that starts at the top of the box, runs down through its middle and falls away to the left. Then a stroke that runs down, bends right along the foot and hooks up at the end.

The small piece, two strokes, inside the bend on the right: a short stroke that falls to the left and turns right, then a dot.

5 + 2 + 2 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 鬼, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 鬼? (**Nine.**) How many pieces? (**Three: the box, the legs, the small piece.**) Which stroke hooks up? (**The seventh, along the foot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 鬼, pinned stroke paths and medians.

332.4 nàoguǐ — to be haunted

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the nerve to face danger, then the Mandarin for a ghost in a story.

You'll want to know: nàoguǐ

nàoguǐ — "to be haunted".

dàjiā dōu shuō nàge fángzi nàoguǐ — Everyone says that house is haunted.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nàoguǐ is built from *nào* 'to make a din' and 鬼 'a ghost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nraewH* and *kjw+jX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'not quiet' and 'to disturb'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: nàoguǐ*
- *Say it: nàoguǐ*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu shuō nàge fángzi nàoguǐ* — Everyone says that house is haunted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the nerve to face danger, then the Mandarin for a ghost in a story, then say *nàoguǐ* again

Before you move on

What does nàoguǐ mean? ("To be haunted".) Say it once more.

332.5 见鬼 (jiànguǐ) — how absurd; curse it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ghost in a story, then the Mandarin for to be haunted by a ghost.

You'll want to know: 见鬼

见鬼 — *jiànguǐ* — "how absurd; curse it".

见鬼了我的手机不见了 *jiànguǐ le wǒ de shǒujī bú jiàn le* — What on earth? My phone's gone!

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

见鬼 (*jiànguǐ*) is built from 见 'to see' and 鬼 'a ghost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kenH* and *kjw+jX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to look'. The exclamation is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànguǐ*
- *Say it: jiànguǐ*, once more
- *Say it: jiànguǐ le wǒ de shǒujī bú jiàn le* — What on earth? My phone's gone!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ghost in a story, then the Mandarin for to be haunted by a ghost, then say *jiànguǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 见鬼 mean? ("How absurd; curse it".) Say it once more.

332.6 人间 (rénjiān) — the human world

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be haunted by a ghost, then the Mandarin for how absurd.

You'll want to know: 人间

人间 — *rénjiān* — "the human world".

传说七月的时候鬼会来人间 *chuánshuō qīyuè de shíhou guǐ huì lái rénjiān* — Legend says that in the seventh month ghosts come into the world of the living.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

人间 (*rénjiān*) is built from 人 'people' and 间 'between', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyin* and *kean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the second under an older form of the character and glosses it 'a gap'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: rénjiān*
- *Say it: rénjiān*, once more
- *Say it: chuánshuō qīyuè de shíhou guǐ huì lái rénjiān* — Legend says that in the seventh month ghosts come into the world of the living.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be haunted by a ghost, then the Mandarin for how absurd, then say *rénjiān* again

Before you move on

What does 人间 mean? ("The human world".) Say it once more.

Chapter 333

New Year's Eve

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about New Year's Eve, the gala on TV, the reunion dinner, staying up and New Year visits.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 333: I can talk about New Year's Eve, the gala on TV, the reunion dinner, staying up and New Year visits.*

333.1 春晚 (Chūnwǎn) — the Spring Festival Gala

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how absurd, then the Mandarin for the human world below.

You'll want to know: 春晚

春晚 — *Chūnwǎn* — "the Spring Festival Gala".

> 每年春节我们都在家看春晚 *měinián Chūnjié wǒmen dōu zài jiā kàn Chūnwǎn* — Every lunar new year we have the gala on at home.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

春晚 (*Chūnwǎn*) is built from 春 'spring' and 晚 'evening', a short form of the longer name of the Spring Festival evening show. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwin* and *mjonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which calls the first the first of the four

seasons and glosses the second 'dusk'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: Chūnwǎn*
- *Say it: Chūnwǎn*, once more
- *Say it: měinián Chūnjié wǒmen dōu zài jiā kàn Chūnwǎn* — Every lunar new year we have the gala on at home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how absurd, then the Mandarin for the human world below, then say *Chūnwǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 春晚 mean? ("The Spring Festival Gala".) Say it once more.

333.2 Chúxī — lunar New Year's Eve

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the human world below, then the Mandarin for the Spring Festival Gala on TV.

You'll want to know: Chúxī

Chúxī — "lunar New Year's Eve".

Chúxī de shíhou wǒmen dōu huí jiā — On the eve of the lunar new year we all go home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Chúxī is built from *chú* 'to clear away' and *xī* 'dusk', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjo* and *zjek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'steps' and 'to remove', and the

second 'dusk'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: Chúxī*
- *Say it: Chúxī*, once more
- *Say it: Chúxī de shíhou wǒmen dōu huí jiā* — On the eve of the lunar new year we all go home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the human world below, then the Mandarin for the Spring Festival Gala on TV, then say *Chúxī* again

Before you move on

What does Chúxī mean? ("Lunar New Year's Eve".) Say it once more.

333.3 niányèfàn — New Year's Eve dinner

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the Spring Festival Gala on TV, then the Mandarin for lunar New Year's Eve.

You'll want to know: niányèfàn

niányèfàn — "New Year's Eve dinner".

Chúxī de wǎnshang wǒmen zài nǎinai jiā chī le niányèfàn — On the last night of the year we had the reunion dinner at my grandma's.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niányèfàn is built from 年 'a year', *yè* 'night' and 饭 'a meal', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *nen*, *yaeH* and *bjonH* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'evening' and says of the third that grain was first cooked into it.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: niányèfàn*
- *Say it: niányèfàn*, once more
- *Say it: Chúxī de wǎnshang wǒmen zài nǎinai jiā chī le niányèfàn* — On the last night of the year we had the reunion dinner at my grandma's.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the Spring Festival Gala on TV, then the Mandarin for lunar New Year's Eve, then say *niányèfàn* again

Before you move on

What does niányèfàn mean? ("New Year's Eve dinner".) Say it once more.

333.4 shǒusuì — to keep the New Year vigil

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lunar New Year's Eve, then the Mandarin for the New Year's Eve dinner.

You'll want to know: shǒusuì

shǒusuì — "to keep the New Year vigil".

chī le niányèfàn yǐhòu wǒmen yìqǐ shǒusuì — After the reunion dinner we stayed up together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǒusuì is built from *shǒu* 'to guard' and 岁 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *sjwejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to keep watch over'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒusuì*
- *Say it: shǒusuì*, once more
- *Say it: chī le niányèfàn yǐhòu wǒmen yìqǐ shǒusuì* — After the reunion dinner we stayed up together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lunar New Year's Eve, then the Mandarin for the New Year's Eve dinner, then say *shǒusuì* again

Before you move on

What does shǒusuì mean? ("To keep the New Year vigil".) Say it once more.

333.5 bàinián — to pay a New Year call

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the New Year's Eve dinner, then the Mandarin for to keep the New Year vigil.

You'll want to know: bàinián

bàinián — "to pay a New Year call".

> *dì'èr tiān wǒmen qù yéye jiā bàinián* — The next day we went to my grandpa's to wish him a happy new year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàinián is built from *bài* 'to bow' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *peajH* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the first among the forms of a bow.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàinián*
- *Say it: bàinián*, once more
- *Say it: dì'èr tiān wǒmen qù yéye jiā bàinián* — The next day we went to my grandpa's to wish him a happy new year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the New Year's Eve dinner, then the Mandarin for to keep the New Year vigil, then say *bàinián* again

Before you move on

What does bàinián mean? ("To pay a New Year call".) Say it once more.

Chapter 334

Red Envelopes

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the first lunar month, red envelopes, couplets by the door and a business doing well.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 334: I can talk about the first lunar month, red envelopes, couplets by the door and a business doing well.*

334.1 正月 (zhēngyuè) — first lunar month

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep the New Year vigil, then the Mandarin for to pay a New Year call.

You'll want to know: 正月

正月 — *zhēngyuè* — "first lunar month".

> 正月里大家都很开心 *zhēngyuè lǐ dàjiā dōu hěn kāixīn* — In the first month everyone is cheerful.

正 is said zhēng here, with a level tone, not the zhèng of 正在.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

正月 (*zhēngyuè*) is built from 正 and 月 'a month', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyeng* and *ngjwot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary gives the first its level-tone reading *tsyeng* for the start of the calendar year, apart from *tsyengH*, 'upright':

so zhēng here, and zhèng in 正在.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhēngyuè*
- *Say it: zhēngyuè*, once more
- *Say it: zhēngyuè lǐ dàjiā dōu hěn kāixīn* — In the first month everyone is cheerful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep the New Year vigil, then the Mandarin for to pay a New Year call, then say *zhēngyuè* again

Before you move on

What does 正月 mean? ("First lunar month".) Say it once more.

334.2 红包 (hóngbāo) — red envelope

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay a New Year call, then the Mandarin for the first lunar month.

You'll want to know: 红包

红包 — *hóngbāo* — "red envelope".

过年的时候外公给了我一个红包 *guònián de shíhou wàigōng gěi le wǒ yí ge hóngbāo* — At the new year my grandpa gave me a red envelope.

The new character, in pieces: 红 — six strokes: on the left the silk piece of 给, three strokes; on the right 工. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

红包 (*hóngbāo*) is built from 红 'red' and 包 'a packet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwng* and *paew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a colour' and the second 'to wrap'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hóngbāo*
- *Say it: hóngbāo*, once more
- *Say it: guònián de shíhou wàigōng gěi le wǒ yí ge hóngbāo* — At the new year my grandpa gave me a red envelope.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay a New Year call, then the Mandarin for the first lunar month, then say *hóngbāo* again

Before you move on

What does 红包 mean? ("Red envelope".) Say it once more.

334.3 红 — the silk piece, then 工

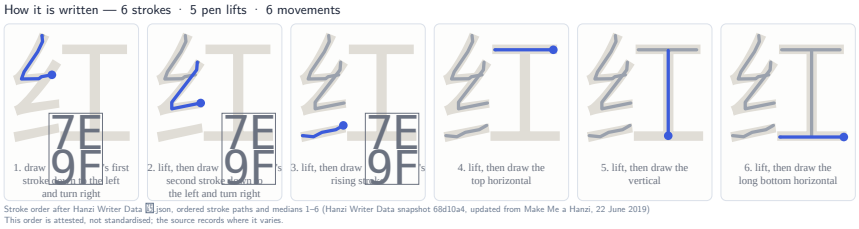
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *hóngbāo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  给 工

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *gěi*, *gōng*

Script — the silk piece, then 工



How 红 is written, stroke by stroke

红

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, three strokes, as on the left of 给: a stroke that falls to the left and turns right, a second one like it below, then a short stroke rising to the right.

The right piece, 工, three strokes. A short bar, a vertical down from its middle, then a longer bar along the foot.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 红, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 红? (**Six.**) Where have you met the left piece? (**On the left of 给.**) What is the right piece? (工.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 红, pinned stroke paths and medians.

334.4 tiē — to stick; to paste up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the first lunar month, then the Mandarin for a red envelope of gift money.

You'll want to know: tiē

tiē — "to stick; to paste up".

> *wǒ zài ménkǒu tiē le yì zhāng hóng zhǐ* — I stuck a sheet of red paper up by the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiē is inherited from Middle Chinese *thep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to pawn something for money'. The sense 'to stick on' is not given there, and how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiē*
- *Say it: tiē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài ménkǒu tiē le yì zhāng hóng zhǐ* — I stuck a sheet of red paper up by the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the first lunar month, then the Mandarin for a red envelope of gift money, then say *tiē* again

Before you move on

What does tiē mean? ("To stick; to paste up".) Say it once more.

334.5 chūnlián — Spring Festival couplets

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a red envelope of gift money, then the Mandarin for to paste up on a door.

You'll want to know: chūnlián

chūnlián — "Spring Festival couplets".

> *Chúxī de xiàwǔ wǒmen zài ménkǒu tiē le chūnlián* — On the afternoon of the last day of the year we put up the couplets by the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūnlián is built from 春 'spring' and *lián* 'to join'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhwin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), the first of the four seasons. The dictionary lists the second only under an older spelling of the character, *ljen*, which it glosses 'unbroken'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūnlián*
- *Say it: chūnlián*, once more
- *Say it: Chúxī de xiàwǔ wǒmen zài ménkǒu tiē le chūnlián* — On the afternoon of the last day of the year we put up the couplets by the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a red envelope of gift money, then the Mandarin for to paste up on a door, then say *chūnlián* again

Before you move on

What does chūnlián mean? ("Spring Festival couplets".) Say it once more.

334.6 红火 (hónghuǒ) — prosperous; flourishing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to paste up on a door, then the Mandarin for the Spring Festival couplets.

You'll want to know: 红火

红火 — *hónghuǒ* — "prosperous; flourishing".

> 这家饭店很红火 *zhè jiā fàndiàn hěn hónghuǒ* — This restaurant is doing very well.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

红火 (*hónghuǒ*) is built from 红 'red' and 火 'fire', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwng* and *xwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a colour' and the second, quoting an older dictionary, 'to blaze'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hónghuǒ*
- *Say it: hónghuǒ*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fàndiàn hěn hónghuǒ* — This restaurant is doing very well.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to paste up on a door, then the Mandarin for the Spring Festival couplets, then say *hónghuǒ* again

Before you move on

What does 红火 mean? ("Prosperous; flourishing".) Say it once more.

Chapter 335

Lanterns and Riddles

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the Lantern Festival, lanterns, riddles and firecrackers, and say I guessed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 335: I can talk about the Lantern Festival, lanterns, riddles and firecrackers, and say I guessed.*

335.1 Yuánxiāo — the Lantern Festival

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the Spring Festival couplets, then the Mandarin for flourishing in business.

You'll want to know: Yuánxiāo

Yuánxiāo — "the Lantern Festival".

> *Yuánxiāo de wǎnshang wǒmen chūqù wán* — On the night of the lantern festival we go out and have fun.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Yuánxiāo is built from 元 'first' and *xiāo* 'night', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwon* and *sjew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'great' and 'the beginning' and the second 'night': the first full-moon night of the year.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: Yuánxiāo*
- *Say it: Yuánxiāo*, once more
- *Say it: Yuánxiāo de wǎnshang wǒmen chūqù wán* — On the night of the lantern festival we go out and have fun.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the Spring Festival couplets, then the Mandarin for flourishing in business, then say *Yuánxiāo* again

Before you move on

What does Yuánxiāo mean? ("The Lantern Festival".) Say it once more.

335.2 dēnglóng — lantern

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for flourishing in business, then the Mandarin for the Lantern Festival.

You'll want to know: dēnglóng

dēnglóng — "lantern".

ménkǒu yǒu liǎng ge hóng dēnglóng — There are two red lanterns at the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēnglóng is built from *dēng* 'a lamp' and *lóng* 'a basket', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong* and *luwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a lamp' and quotes an older book for the second, a basket for a fire.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēnglóng*
- *Say it: dēnglóng*, once more
- *Say it: ménkǒu yǒu liǎng ge hóng dēnglóng* — There are two red lanterns at the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for flourishing in business, then the Mandarin for the Lantern Festival, then say *dēnglóng* again

Before you move on

What does dēnglóng mean? ("Lantern".) Say it once more.

335.3 cāi — to guess

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the Lantern Festival, then the Mandarin for a paper lantern.

You'll want to know: cāi

cāi — "to guess".

wǒ cāi le sān cì dōu bú duì — I guessed three times and got it wrong each time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cāi is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to suspect' and 'to resent'. The sense 'to guess' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: cāi*
- *Say it: cāi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ cāi le sān cì dōu bú duì* — I guessed three times and got it wrong each time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the Lantern Festival, then the Mandarin for a paper lantern, then say *cāi* again

Before you move on

What does cāi mean? ("To guess".) Say it once more.

335.4 míyǔ — riddle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a paper lantern, then the Mandarin for to guess an answer.

You'll want to know: míyǔ

míyǔ — "riddle".

Yuánxiāo de shíhou wǒmen cāi míyǔ — At the lantern festival we guess riddles.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

míyǔ is built from *mí* and 语 'speech', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mejH* and *ngjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'veiled words'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: míyǔ*
- *Say it: míyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: Yuánxiāo de shíhou wǒmen cāi míyǔ* — At the lantern festival we guess riddles.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a paper lantern, then the Mandarin for to guess an answer, then say *míyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does míyǔ mean? ("Riddle".) Say it once more.

335.5 biānpào — firecrackers

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to guess an answer, then the Mandarin for a riddle.

You'll want to know: biānpào

biānpào — "firecrackers".

> *Chúxī wǎnshang shí'èr diǎn wàibian de rén dōu zài fàng biānpào* — At midnight on the last night of the year everyone outside is letting off firecrackers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biānpào is built from *biān* 'a whip' and *pào*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjien* and *phaewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a horse whip' and the second 'the look of something scorched'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: biānpào*
- *Say it: biānpào*, once more
- *Say it: Chúxī wǎnshang shí'èr diǎn wàibian de rén dōu zài fàng biānpào* — At midnight on the last night of the year everyone outside is letting off firecrackers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to guess an answer, then the Mandarin for a riddle, then say *biānpào* again

Before you move on

What does biānpào mean? ("Firecrackers".) Say it once more.

335.6 Looking back: from The King's Son to Lanterns and Riddles

Say the Mandarin for to inherit the family business and a prince.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to inherit the family business, a prince, a king in a story, a king's wife, a kingdom ruled by a king
- *Say it:* a monster in a story, a Daoist immortal, magic in a fairy tale, a precious treasure, to hide away
- *Say it:* the nerve to face danger, a ghost in a story, to be haunted by a ghost, how absurd, the human world below
- *Say it:* the Spring Festival Gala on TV, lunar New Year's Eve, the New Year's Eve dinner, to keep the New Year vigil, to pay a New Year call
- *Say it:* the first lunar month, a red envelope of gift money, to paste up on a door, the Spring Festival couplets, flourishing in business
- *Say it:* the Lantern Festival, a paper lantern, to guess an answer, a riddle, a string of firecrackers
- *Read it:* 王 鬼 红 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To inherit the family business? (*jìchéng.*) A prince? (王子, *wángzǐ.*) A king in a story? (国王, *guówáng.*) A king's wife? (王后, *wánghòu.*) A kingdom ruled by a king? (王国, *wángguó.*) A monster in a story? (*yāoguài.*) A Daoist immortal? (*shénxiān.*) Magic in a fairy tale? (*mófǎ.*) A precious treasure? (*bǎowù.*) To hide away? (*cáng.*) The nerve to face danger? (*dǎnzi.*) A ghost in a story? (鬼, *guǐ.*) To be haunted by a ghost? (*nàoguǐ.*) How absurd? (见鬼, *jiànguǐ.*) The human world below? (人间, *rénjiān.*) The Spring Festival Gala on TV? (春晚, *Chūnwǎn.*) Lunar New Year's Eve? (*Chúxī.*) The New Year's Eve dinner? (*niányèfàn.*) To keep the New Year vigil? (*shǒusuì.*) To pay a New Year call? (*bàinián.*) The first lunar month? (正月, *zhēngyuè.*) A red envelope of gift money? (红包, *hóngbāo.*) To paste up on a door? (*tiē.*) The Spring Festival couplets? (*chūnlián.*) Flourishing in business? (红火, *hónghuǒ.*) The Lantern Festival? (*Yuánxiāo.*) A paper lantern? (*dēnglóng.*) To guess an answer? (*cāi.*) A riddle? (*míyǔ.*) A string of firecrackers? (*biānpào.*)

Chapter 336

Seeing Friends Off

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say goodbye, give someone a send-off, see a guest to the door, give a present and shake hands.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 336: I can say goodbye, give someone a send-off, see a guest to the door, give a present and shake hands.*

336.1 gàobié — to say goodbye; to take leave

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a riddle, then the Mandarin for a string of firecrackers.

You'll want to know: gàobié

gàobié — "to say goodbye; to take leave".

> *tā hé dàjiā gàobié yǐhòu jiù shàng chē le* — After saying goodbye to everyone he got on board.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gàobié is built from *gào* 'to tell' and *bié* 'to part', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kawH* and *bjet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to report' and the second 'to differ' and 'to part'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gàobié*
- *Say it: gàobié*, once more
- *Say it: tā hé dàjiā gàobié yǐhòu jiù shàng chē le* — After saying goodbye to everyone he got on board.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a riddle, then the Mandarin for a string of firecrackers, then say *gàobié* again

Before you move on

What does gàobié mean? ("To say goodbye; to take leave".) Say it once more.

336.2 欢送 (huānsòng) — to give a send-off

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a string of firecrackers, then the Mandarin for to take leave of someone.

You'll want to know: 欢送

欢送 — *huānsòng* — "to give a send-off".

> 我们开了一个晚会欢送他 *wǒmen kāi le yí ge wǎnhuì huānsòng tā* — We held a party to see him off.

The new character, in pieces: 送 — nine strokes: 关 with its last stroke shrunk to a dot, inside the walking piece of 辶, which wraps it from the left and runs along the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

欢送 (*huānsòng*) is built from 欢 'glad' and *sòng* 'to send', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwan* and *suwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'joy' and the second 'to

send away’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: huānsòng*
- *Say it: huānsòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen kāi le yí ge wǎnhuì huānsòng tā* — We held a party to see him off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a string of firecrackers, then the Mandarin for to take leave of someone, then say *huānsòng* again

Before you move on

What does 欢送 mean? (“To give a send-off”.) Say it once more.

336.3 送 — 关 in the walking piece

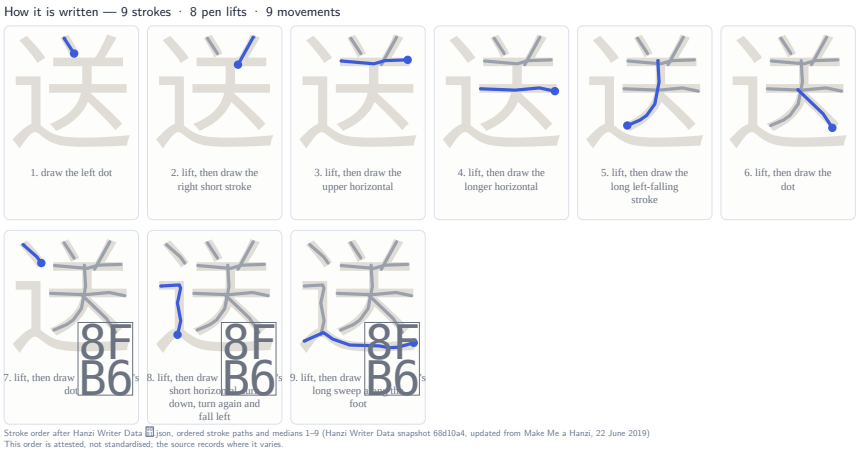
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *huānsòng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  关 这

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *guān*, *zhè*

Script — 关 in the walking piece



How 送 *is written, stroke by stroke*

送

Two pieces: the inside first, then the piece that wraps it.

The inside piece, 关, six strokes, as you wrote it: two short strokes on top, two bars, a long stroke falling to the left, and last the stroke falling to the right, which here shrinks to a dot.

The walking piece, three strokes, as in 这: a dot, a small stroke that zigzags down, then a long sweep along the foot to the right.

6 + 3 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 送, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 送? (**Nine.**) What sits inside? (关.) What is written last? (**The long sweep along the foot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 送, pinned stroke paths and medians.

336.4 送客 (sòngkè) — to see a guest out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take leave of someone, then the Mandarin for to give a send-off.

You'll want to know: 送客

送客 — *sòngkè* — "to see a guest out".

客人走的时候他去门口送客 *kèrén zǒu de shíhou tā qù ménkǒu sòngkè* — When the guests left, he saw them to the door.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

送客 (*sòngkè*) is built from 送 'to send' and 客 'a guest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *suwngH* and *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a guest'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: sòngkè*
- *Say it: sòngkè*, once more
- *Say it: kèrén zǒu de shíhou tā qù ménkǒu sòngkè* — When the guests left, he saw them to the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take leave of someone, then the Mandarin for to give a send-off, then say *sòngkè* again

Before you move on

What does 送客 mean? ("To see a guest out".) Say it once more.

336.5 sònglǐ — to give a present

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give a send-off, then the Mandarin for to see a guest out.

You'll want to know: sònglǐ

sònglǐ — "to give a present".

> *Chūnjié de shíhou Zhōngguó rén chángcháng sònglǐ* — At the lunar new year Chinese people often give presents.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sònglǐ is built from 送 'to send' and *lǐ* 'a courtesy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *suwngH* and *lejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says of the second, quoting an older dictionary, that it is how one serves the spirits and brings blessing.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: sònglǐ*
- *Say it: sònglǐ*, once more
- *Say it: Chūnjié de shíhou Zhōngguó rén chángcháng sònglǐ* — At the lunar new year Chinese people often give presents.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give a send-off, then the Mandarin for to see a guest out, then say *sònglǐ* again

Before you move on

What does sònglǐ mean? ("To give a present".) Say it once more.

336.6 wòshǒu — to shake hands

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to see a guest out, then the Mandarin for to give a present.

You'll want to know: wòshǒu

wòshǒu — "to shake hands".

> *gàobié de shíhou wǒmen wòshǒu le* — When we said goodbye, we shook hands.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wòshǒu is built from *wò* 'to grasp' and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'aewk* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wòshǒu*
- *Say it: wòshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: gàobié de shíhou wǒmen wòshǒu le* — When we said goodbye, we shook hands.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to see a guest out, then the Mandarin for to give a present, then say *wòshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does wòshǒu mean? ("To shake hands".) Say it once more.

Chapter 337

Best Wishes

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can congratulate someone, wish them well and good luck, give a token of my regard and make a wish.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 337: I can congratulate someone, wish them well and good luck, give a token of my regard and make a wish.*

337.1 gōngxǐ — to congratulate

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give a present, then the Mandarin for to shake hands with someone.

You'll want to know: gōngxǐ

gōngxǐ — "to congratulate".

> *gōngxǐ nǐ zhǎodào le xīn gōngzuò* — Congratulations on finding a new job.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngxǐ is built from *gōng* and 喜 'joy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjowng* and *xiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'respectful' and the second 'joy'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngxǐ*
- *Say it: gōngxǐ*, once more
- *Say it: gōngxǐ nǐ zhǎodào le xīn gōngzuò* — Congratulations on finding a new job.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give a present, then the Mandarin for to shake hands with someone, then say *gōngxǐ* again

Before you move on

What does gōngxǐ mean? ("To congratulate".) Say it once more.

337.2 祝 (zhù) — to wish someone well

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shake hands with someone, then the Mandarin for to congratulate someone.

You'll want to know: 祝

祝 — *zhù* — "to wish someone well".

祝你生日快乐 *zhù nǐ shēngrì kuàilè* — Happy birthday to you!

The new character, in pieces: 祝 — nine strokes: on the left a spirit piece of four strokes, a dot, a stroke that runs right and turns down to the left, a vertical and a dot; on the right 口 over 儿. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

祝 (*zhù*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it, quoting an older dictionary, as the words of praise spoken by the master of a sacrifice. The dictionary also lists *tsyuwk*, 'one who calls on the spirits'; the falling

tone of zhù matches the first.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhù*
- *Say it: zhù*, once more
- *Say it: zhù nǐ shēngrì kuàilè* — Happy birthday to you!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shake hands with someone, then the Mandarin for to congratulate someone, then say *zhù* again

Before you move on

What does 祝 mean? ("To wish someone well".) Say it once more.

337.3 祝 — the spirit piece, then 口 over 儿

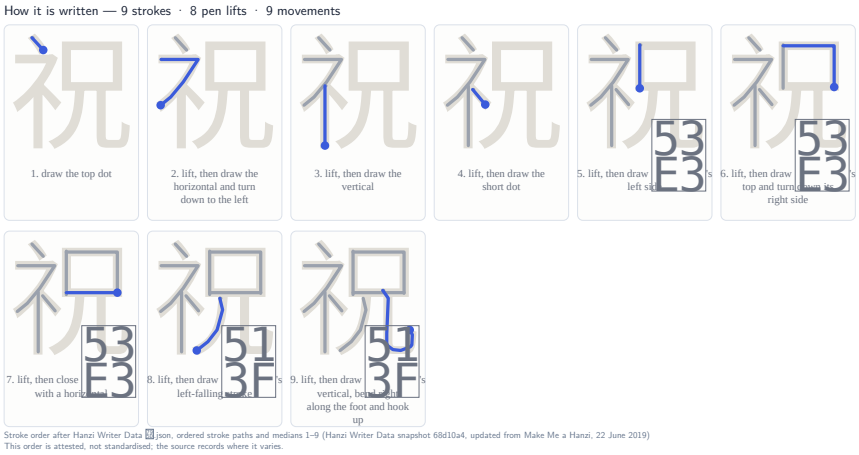
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 儿

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *ér*

Script — the spirit piece, then 口 over 儿



How 祝 is written, stroke by stroke

祝

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, the spirit piece, four strokes. A dot. A bar that runs right and turns down to the left. A vertical under it. Then a short dot at its right.

The right piece, five strokes. First 口: a short vertical, a bar that turns down, the bar that closes it. Under it 儿: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up.

4 + 5 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 祝, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 祝? (**Nine.**) What is on the right? (**口 over 儿.**) How does the spirit piece end? (**With a short dot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 祝, pinned stroke paths and medians.

337.4 心意 (xīnyì) — kind thoughts; a token of regard

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to congratulate someone, then the Mandarin for to wish someone well.

You'll want to know: 心意

心意 — *xīnyì* — "kind thoughts; a token of regard".

> 我们送你一个红包这是我们的一点儿心意 *wǒmen sòng nǐ yí ge hóngbāo zhè shì wǒmen de yìdiǎnr xīnyì* — We're giving you a red envelope, a small token of our regard.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心意 (*xīnyì*) is built from 心 'the heart' and 意 'intent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the will'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnyì*
- *Say it: xīnyì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen sòng nǐ yí ge hóngbāo zhè shì wǒmen de yìdiǎnr xīnyì* — We're giving you a red envelope, a small token of our regard.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to congratulate someone, then the Mandarin for to wish someone well, then say *xīnyì* again

Before you move on

What does 心意 mean? ("Kind thoughts; a token of regard".) Say it once more.

337.5 hǎoyùn — good luck

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wish someone well, then the Mandarin for a token of regard.

You'll want to know: hǎoyùn

hǎoyùn — "good luck".

zǒu yǐqián dàjiā dōu zhù wǒ hǎoyùn — Before I left, everyone wished me good luck.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎoyùn is built from 好 'good' and *yùn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *hjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to move' and 'to carry'. The sense 'luck' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎoyùn*
- *Say it: hǎoyùn*, once more
- *Say it: zǒu yǐqián dàjiā dōu zhù wǒ hǎoyùn* — Before I left, everyone wished me good luck.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wish someone well, then the Mandarin for a token of regard, then say *hǎoyùn* again

Before you move on

What does hǎoyùn mean? ("Good luck".) Say it once more.

337.6 xǔyuàn — to make a wish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a token of regard, then the Mandarin for good luck.

You'll want to know: xǔyuàn

xǔyuàn — "to make a wish".

shēngrì nà tiān tā xiān xǔyuàn ránhòu chī dàngāo — On his birthday he made a wish first and then ate the cake.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǔyuàn is built from *xǔ* and *yuàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjoX* and *ngjwonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and 'to grant', and the second 'to desire'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǔyuàn*
- *Say it: xǔyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: shēngrì nà tiān tā xiān xǔyuàn ránhòu chī dàngāo* — On his birthday he made a wish first and then ate the cake.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a token of regard, then the Mandarin for good luck, then say *xǔyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does xǔyuàn mean? ("To make a wish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 338

Festival Visits

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about spending a festival at home, paying visits, family reunions, days off and local customs.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 338: I can talk about spending a festival at home, paying visits, family reunions, days off and local customs.*

338.1 过节 (guòjié) — to celebrate a festival

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for good luck, then the Mandarin for to make a wish.

You'll want to know: 过节

过节 — *guòjié* — "to celebrate a festival".

> 去年我们回老家过节 *qùnián wǒmen huí lǎojiā guòjié* — Last year we went back to our home town for the festival.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

过节 (*guòjié*) is built from 过 'to pass' and 节 'a festival', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaH* and *tset* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go beyond' and the second 'a joint of bamboo'. The sense 'a festival' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guòjié*
- *Say it: guòjié*, once more
- *Say it: qùnián wǒmen huí lǎojiā guòjié* — Last year we went back to our home town for the festival.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for good luck, then the Mandarin for to make a wish, then say *guòjié* again

Before you move on

What does 过节 mean? ("To celebrate a festival".) Say it once more.

338.2 bàifǎng — to pay a visit to

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a wish, then the Mandarin for to celebrate a festival.

You'll want to know: bàifǎng

bàifǎng — "to pay a visit to".

guòjié de shíhou wǒmen qù bàifǎng le lǎoshī — Over the festival we went to visit our teacher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàifǎng is built from *bài* 'to bow' and *fǎng* 'to call on', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *peajH* and *phjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to consult'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàifǎng*
- *Say it: bàifǎng*, once more
- *Say it: guòjié de shíhou wǒmen qù bàifǎng le lǎoshī* — Over the festival we went to visit our teacher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a wish, then the Mandarin for to celebrate a festival, then say *bàifǎng* again

Before you move on

What does bàifǎng mean? ("To pay a visit to".) Say it once more.

338.3 tuányuán — to be reunited as a family

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to celebrate a festival, then the Mandarin for to pay a visit to someone.

You'll want to know: tuányuán

tuányuán — "to be reunited as a family".

> *guònián de shíhou jiārén dōu huílai tuányuán* — At the new year the whole family comes back together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuányuán is built from *tuán* and *yuán*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dwan* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with this very word and the second 'the round body of the heavens'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuánnyuán*
- *Say it: tuánnyuán*, once more
- *Say it: guònián de shíhou jiārén dōu huílai tuánnyuán* — At the new year the whole family comes back together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to celebrate a festival, then the Mandarin for to pay a visit to someone, then say *tuánnyuán* again

Before you move on

What does tuánnyuán mean? ("To be reunited as a family".) Say it once more.

338.4 假日 (jiàrì) — holiday; day off

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pay a visit to someone, then the Mandarin for to be reunited as a family.

You'll want to know: 假日

假日 — *jiàrì* — "holiday; day off".

祝你假日快乐 *zhù nǐ jiàrì kuàilè* — Have a happy holiday!

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

假日 (*jiàrì*) is built from 假 'leave' and 日 'a day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaeH* and *nyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first in this falling tone 'a holiday from work'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàrì*
- *Say it: jiàrì*, once more

- *Say it: zhù nǐ jiàrì kuàilè* — Have a happy holiday!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pay a visit to someone, then the Mandarin for to be reunited as a family, then say *jiàrì* again

Before you move on

What does 假日 mean? ("Holiday; day off".) Say it once more.

338.5 fēngsú — custom; social custom

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be reunited as a family, then the Mandarin for a day off work.

You'll want to know: fēngsú

fēngsú — "custom; social custom".

měi ge dìfang de fēngsú dōu bù yíyàng — Every place has its own customs.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēngsú is built from 风 'wind' and *sú* 'usage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwng* and *zjowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second with this very word.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēngsú*
- *Say it: fēngsú*, once more
- *Say it: měi ge dìfang de fēngsú dōu bù yíyàng* — Every place has its own customs.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be reunited as a family, then the Mandarin for a day off work, then say *fēngsú* again

Before you move on

What does fēngsú mean? ("Custom; social custom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 339

National Day

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a long holiday, National Day, celebrating, a festive house and fireworks.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 339: I can talk about a long holiday, National Day, celebrating, a festive house and fireworks.*

339.1 长假 (chángjià) — long holiday

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a day off work, then the Mandarin for a local custom.

You'll want to know: 长假

长假 — *chángjià* — "long holiday".

> 十月有一个长假 *shíyuè yǒu yí ge chángjià* — There's a long holiday in October.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

长假 (*chángjià*) is built from 长 'long' and 假 'leave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjang* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'long' and 'far' and the second 'a holiday from work'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chángjià*
- *Say it: chángjià*, once more
- *Say it: shíyuè yǒu yí ge chángjià* — There's a long holiday in October.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a day off work, then the Mandarin for a local custom, then say *chángjià* again

Before you move on

What does 长假 mean? ("Long holiday".) Say it once more.

339.2 国庆 (Guóqìng) — National Day

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a local custom, then the Mandarin for a long holiday.

You'll want to know: 国庆

国庆 — *Guóqìng* — "National Day".

国庆的时候我们回了老家 *Guóqìng de shíhou wǒmen huí le lǎojiā* — Over the national holiday we went back to our home town.

The new character, in pieces: 庆 — six strokes: the roof piece of 店, a dot, a bar and a long stroke falling to the left; under it 大. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

国庆 (*Guóqìng*) is built from 国 'a state' and *qìng* 'to celebrate', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *khjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to congratulate' and 'good fortune'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: Guóqìng*
- *Say it: Guóqìng*, once more
- *Say it: Guóqìng de shíhou wǒmen huí le lǎojiā* — Over the national holiday we went back to our home town.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a local custom, then the Mandarin for a long holiday, then say *Guóqìng* again

Before you move on

What does 国庆 mean? ("National Day".) Say it once more.

339.3 庆 — the roof piece over 大

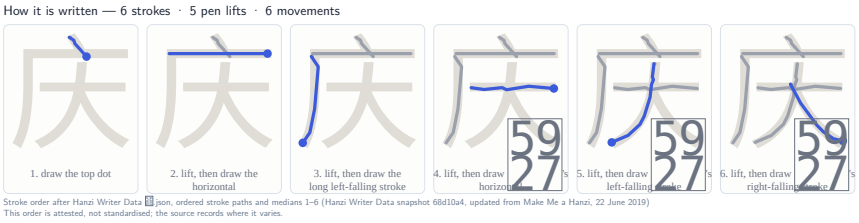
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *Guóqìng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  店 大

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *diàn*, *dà*

Script — the roof piece over 大



How 庆 is written, stroke by stroke

庆

Two pieces: the roof first, then what sits under it.

The roof piece, three strokes, as on 店: a dot, a bar, then a long stroke falling to the left down the side.

The piece under it, 大, three strokes: a bar, a stroke falling to the left through it, then a stroke falling to the right.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 庆, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 庆? (**Six.**) What is the roof? (**The roof piece of 店.**) What sits under it? (大.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 庆, pinned stroke paths and medians.

339.4 庆祝 (qìngzhù) — to celebrate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a long holiday, then the Mandarin for the National Day holiday.

You'll want to know: 庆祝

庆祝 — *qìngzhù* — "to celebrate".

我们一起庆祝国庆 *wǒmen yìqǐ qìngzhù Guóqìng* — We celebrate the national holiday together.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

庆祝 (*qìngzhù*) is built from 庆 'to congratulate' and 祝 'to bless', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khjaengH* and *tsyuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to congratulate'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qìngzhù*
- *Say it: qìngzhù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yìqǐ qìngzhù Guóqìng* — We celebrate the national holiday together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a long holiday, then the Mandarin for the National Day holiday, then say *qìngzhù* again

Before you move on

What does 庆祝 mean? ("To celebrate".) Say it once more.

339.5 喜庆 (xǐqìng) — festive; joyous

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the National Day holiday, then the Mandarin for to celebrate a happy event.

You'll want to know: 喜庆

喜庆 — *xǐqìng* — "festive; joyous".

过年的时候家里很喜庆 *guònián de shíhou jiā lǐ hěn xǐqìng* — At the new year the house is full of festive joy.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

喜庆 (*xǐqìng*) is built from 喜 'joy' and 庆 'good fortune', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xiX* and *khjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'joy' and the second 'good fortune'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǐqìng*
- *Say it: xǐqìng*, once more
- *Say it: guònián de shíhou jiā lǐ hěn xǐqìng* — At the new year the house is full of festive joy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the National Day holiday, then the Mandarin for to celebrate a happy event, then say *xǐqìng* again

Before you move on

What does 喜庆 mean? ("Festive; joyous".) Say it once more.

339.6 yānhuā — fireworks

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to celebrate a happy event, then the Mandarin for full of festive joy.

You'll want to know: yānhuā

yānhuā — "fireworks".

Guóqìng de wǎnshang wǒmen kàn le yānhuā — On the evening of the national holiday we saw the fireworks.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yānhuā is built from *yān* 'smoke' and 花 'a flower', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'en* and *xwae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the breath of fire'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yānhuā*
- *Say it: yānhuā*, once more
- *Say it: Guóqìng de wǎnshang wǒmen kàn le yānhuā* — On the evening of the national holiday we saw the fireworks.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to celebrate a happy event, then the Mandarin for full of festive joy, then say *yānhuā* again

Before you move on

What does yānhuā mean? (“Fireworks”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 340

Old Ways

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about traditions, being particular about them, proper rules, the solar terms and tending graves.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 340: I can talk about traditions, being particular about them, proper rules, the solar terms and tending graves.*

340.1 chuántǒng — tradition

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for full of festive joy, then the Mandarin for fireworks lighting up the sky.

You'll want to know: chuántǒng

chuántǒng — "tradition".

> *guònián chī jiǎozi shì yí ge lǎo chuántǒng* — Eating dumplings at the new year is an old tradition.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuántǒng is built from 传 'to pass on' and *tǒng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjwen* and *thowngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to gather together' and 'the

end of a thread'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuántǒng*
- *Say it: chuántǒng*, once more
- *Say it: guònián chī jiǎozi shì yí ge lǎo chuántǒng* — Eating dumplings at the new year is an old tradition.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for full of festive joy, then the Mandarin for fireworks lighting up the sky, then say *chuántǒng* again

Before you move on

What does chuántǒng mean? ("Tradition".) Say it once more.

340.2 jiǎngjiu — to be particular about

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fireworks lighting up the sky, then the Mandarin for an old tradition.

You'll want to know: jiǎngjiu

jiǎngjiu — "to be particular about".

wǒ nǎinai hěn jiǎngjiu chī — My grandma is very particular about food.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎngjiu is built from *jiǎng* and *jiū*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngX* and *kjuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to discuss' and the second 'to go to the end' and 'deep'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎngjiu*
- *Say it: jiǎngjiu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nǎinai hěn jiǎngjiu chī* — My grandma is very particular about food.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fireworks lighting up the sky, then the Mandarin for an old tradition, then say *jiǎngjiu* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎngjiu mean? ("To be particular about".) Say it once more.

340.3 guījù — rules of conduct; manners

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an old tradition, then the Mandarin for to be particular about details.

You'll want to know: guījù

guījù — "rules of conduct; manners".

> *chī niányèfàn yǒu shénme guījù* — What are the rules at the reunion dinner?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guījù is built from *guī* 'a compass' and *jǔ* 'a set square', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjwie* and *kjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'round', quoting an older book that uses this very pair, and the second 'a rule'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guījù*
- *Say it: guījù*, once more
- *Say it: chī niányèfàn yǒu shénme guījù* — What are the rules at the reunion dinner?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an old tradition, then the Mandarin for to be particular about details, then say *guījù* again

Before you move on

What does guījù mean? ("Rules of conduct; manners".) Say it once more.

340.4 节气 (jiéqì) — solar term

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be particular about details, then the Mandarin for the rules of conduct.

You'll want to know: 节气

节气 — *jiéqì* — "solar term".

每年有二十四个节气 *měinián yǒu èrshísì ge jiéqì* — Every year has twenty-four solar terms.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

节气 (*jiéqì*) is built from 节 'a joint' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tset* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a joint of bamboo' and the second 'breath'. The calendar sense is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiéqì*
- *Say it: jiéqì*, once more
- *Say it: měinián yǒu èrshísì ge jiéqì* — Every year has twenty-four solar terms.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be particular about details, then the Mandarin for the rules of conduct, then say *jiéqì* again

Before you move on

What does 节气 mean? ("Solar term".) Say it once more.

340.5 sǎomù — to tend the family graves

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the rules of conduct, then the Mandarin for a solar term of the year.

You'll want to know: sǎomù

sǎomù — "to tend the family graves".

> *měinián chūntiān wǒmen dōu qù sǎomù* — Every spring we go to tend the family graves.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sǎomù is built from 扫 'to sweep' and *mù* 'a grave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sawX* and *muH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to sweep clean' and the second 'a grave mound'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǎomù*
- *Say it: sǎomù*, once more
- *Say it: měinián chūntiān wǒmen dōu qù sǎomù* — Every spring we go to tend the family graves.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the rules of conduct, then the Mandarin for a solar term of the year, then say *sǎomù* again

Before you move on

What does sǎomù mean? ("To tend the family graves".) Say it once more.

340.6 Looking back: from Seeing Friends Off to Old Ways

Say the Mandarin for to take leave of someone and to give a send-off.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to take leave of someone, to give a send-off, to see a guest out, to give a present, to shake hands with someone
- *Say it:* to congratulate someone, to wish someone well, a token of regard, good luck, to make a wish
- *Say it:* to celebrate a festival, to pay a visit to someone, to be reunited as a family, a day off work, a local custom
- *Say it:* a long holiday, the National Day holiday, to celebrate a happy event, full of festive joy, fireworks lighting up the sky
- *Say it:* an old tradition, to be particular about details, the rules of conduct, a solar term of the year, to tend the family graves

- *Read it:* 送 祝 庆 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To take leave of someone? (*gàobié.*) To give a send-off? (欢送, *huānsòng.*) To see a guest out? (送客, *sòngkè.*) To give a present? (*sònglǐ.*) To shake hands with someone? (*wòshǒu.*) To congratulate someone? (*gōngxǐ.*) To wish someone well? (祝, *zhù.*) A token of regard? (心意, *xīnyì.*) Good luck? (*hǎoyùn.*) To make a wish? (*xǔyuàn.*) To celebrate a festival? (过节, *guòjié.*) To pay a visit to someone? (*bàifǎng.*) To be reunited as a family? (*tuányuán.*) A day off work? (假日, *jiàrì.*) A local custom? (*fēngsú.*) A long holiday? (长假, *chángjià.*) The National Day holiday? (国庆, *Guóqìng.*) To celebrate a happy event? (庆祝, *qìngzhù.*) Full of festive joy? (喜庆, *xǐqìng.*) Fireworks lighting up the sky? (*yānhuā.*) An old tradition? (*chuántǒng.*) To be particular about details? (*jiǎngjiu.*) The rules of conduct? (*guījù.*) A solar term of the year? (节气, *jiéqì.*) To tend the family graves? (*sǎomù.*)

Chapter 341

Mooncakes

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about mooncakes, bean paste, fillings and tasting, and say business is good.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 341: I can talk about mooncakes, bean paste, fillings and tasting, and say business is good.*

341.1 dòushā — sweet bean paste

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a solar term of the year, then the Mandarin for to tend the family graves.

You'll want to know: dòushā

dòushā — "sweet bean paste".

> *zhège miànbāo lǐ yǒu dòushā* — There's bean paste in this bun.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dòushā is built from *dòu* 'beans' and *shā* 'sand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwH* and *srae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'beans' and the second 'grit scattered by water'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: dòushā*
- *Say it: dòushā*, once more
- *Say it: zhège miànbāo lǐ yǒu dòushā* — There's bean paste in this bun.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a solar term of the year, then the Mandarin for to tend the family graves, then say *dòushā* again

Before you move on

What does dòushā mean? ("Sweet bean paste".) Say it once more.

341.2 月饼 (yuèbǐng) — mooncake

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to tend the family graves, then the Mandarin for sweet bean paste.

You'll want to know: 月饼

月饼 — *yuèbǐng* — "mooncake".

我买了两个月饼 *wǒ mǎi le liǎng ge yuèbǐng* — I bought two mooncakes.

The new character, in pieces: 饼 — nine strokes: on the left the food piece of 饭, three strokes; on the right two short strokes, two bars, and two strokes down. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

月饼 (*yuèbǐng*) is built from 月 'the moon' and 饼 'a cake', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwot* and *pjiengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which gives the second only its reading.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuèbǐng*
- *Say it: yuèbǐng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎi le liǎng ge yuèbǐng* — I bought two mooncakes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to tend the family graves, then the Mandarin for sweet bean paste, then say *yuèbǐng* again

Before you move on

What does 月饼 mean? ("Mooncake".) Say it once more.

341.3 饼 — the food piece, then two bars and two legs

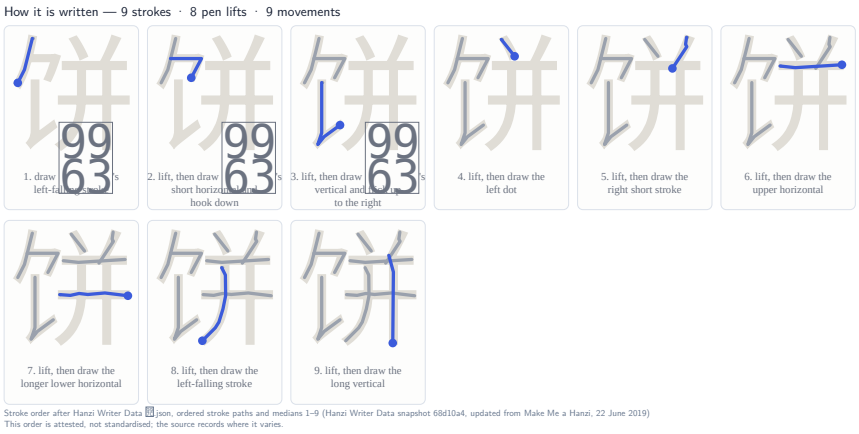
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yuèbǐng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  饭 月

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *fàn*, *yuè*

Script — the food piece, then two bars and two legs



How 饼 *is written, stroke by stroke*

饼

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, the food piece, three strokes, as in 饭: a stroke falling to the left, a short bar that turns down to the left, then a vertical that flicks up to the right.

The right piece, six strokes. Two short strokes on top, the left one a dot, the right one falling to the left. Two bars, the lower one longer. Then a stroke down the left that falls away to the left, and a vertical down the right.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 饼, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 饼? (**Nine.**) Where have you met the left piece? (**On the left of 饭.**) How many bars on the right? (**Two.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 饼, pinned stroke paths and medians.

341.4 xiànr — filling

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sweet bean paste, then the Mandarin for a mooncake.

You'll want to know: xiànr

xiànr — "filling".

zhège yuèbǐng de xiànr shì dòushā — This mooncake has a bean-paste filling.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiànr No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled. The ending r is the 儿 of 一会儿.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiànr*
- *Say it: xiànr*, once more
- *Say it: zhège yuèbǐng de xiànr shì dòushā* — This mooncake has a bean-paste filling.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sweet bean paste, then the Mandarin for a mooncake, then say *xiànr* again

Before you move on

What does xiànr mean? ("Filling".) Say it once more.

341.5 pǐncháng — to taste; to sample

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a mooncake, then the Mandarin for the filling of a dumpling.

You'll want to know: pǐncháng

pǐncháng — "to taste; to sample".

dàjiā dōu pǐncháng le wǒ zuò de yuèbǐng — Everyone tasted the mooncakes I made.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pǐncháng is built from *pǐn* and *cháng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phimX* and *dzyang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a rank' and 'a kind', and the second 'to try' and, quoting an older dictionary, 'to taste with the mouth'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: pǐncháng*
- *Say it: pǐncháng*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu pǐncháng le wǒ zuò de yuèbǐng* — Everyone tasted the mooncakes I made.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a mooncake, then the Mandarin for the filling of a dumpling, then say *pǐncháng* again

Before you move on

What does pǐncháng mean? ("To taste; to sample".) Say it once more.

341.6 生意 (shēngyi) — business; trade

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the filling of a dumpling, then the Mandarin for to taste food with care.

You'll want to know: 生意

生意 — *shēngyi* — "business; trade".

每年这个时候月饼的生意最好 *měinián zhège shíhou yuèbǐng de shēngyi zuì hǎo* — Every year at this time the mooncake trade is at its best.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生意 (*shēngyi*) is built from 生 'life' and 意 'intent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to grow' and the second 'the will'. How the pair came to mean business is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngyi*
- *Say it: shēngyi*, once more
- *Say it: měinián zhège shíhou yuèbǐng de shēngyi zuì hǎo* — Every year at this time the mooncake trade is at its best.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the filling of a dumpling, then the Mandarin for to taste food with care, then say *shēngyi* again

Before you move on

What does 生意 mean? ("Business; trade".) Say it once more.

Chapter 342

Mid-Autumn

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the Mid-Autumn Festival, enjoying the moon, the festival days, osmanthus and home.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 342: I can talk about the Mid-Autumn Festival, enjoying the moon, the festival days, osmanthus and home.*

342.1 shǎngyuè — to enjoy the moon

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to taste food with care, then the Mandarin for trade in a shop.

You'll want to know: shǎngyuè

shǎngyuè — "to enjoy the moon".

> *wǎnshang wǒmen yìqǐ zài wàibian shǎngyuè* — In the evening we sat outside together enjoying the moon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǎngyuè is built from *shǎng* and 月 'the moon', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syangX* and *ngjwot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to bestow'. The sense 'to enjoy' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǎngyuè*
- *Say it: shǎngyuè*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang wǒmen yìqǐ zài wàibian shǎngyuè* — In the evening we sat outside together enjoying the moon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to taste food with care, then the Mandarin for trade in a shop, then say *shǎngyuè* again

Before you move on

What does shǎngyuè mean? ("To enjoy the moon".) Say it once more.

342.2 中秋 (Zhōngqiū) — the Mid-Autumn Festival

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for trade in a shop, then the Mandarin for to enjoy the moon.

You'll want to know: 中秋

中秋 — *Zhōngqiū* — "the Mid-Autumn Festival".

> 中秋的时候我们都吃月饼 *Zhōngqiū de shíhou wǒmen dōu chī yuèbǐng* — At the moon festival we all eat mooncakes.

The new character, in pieces: 秋 — nine strokes: on the left the grain piece of 和, five strokes; on the right 火. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中秋 (*Zhōngqiū*) is built from 中 'the middle' and 秋 'autumn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *tshjuw* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, among other senses, 'half', and says of the second, quoting an older dictionary, that it is when the grain ripens.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: Zhōngqiū*
- *Say it: Zhōngqiū*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngqiū de shíhou wǒmen dōu chī yuèbǐng* — At the moon festival we all eat mooncakes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for trade in a shop, then the Mandarin for to enjoy the moon, then say *Zhōngqiū* again

Before you move on

What does 中秋 mean? ("The Mid-Autumn Festival".) Say it once more.

342.3 秋 — the grain piece, then 火

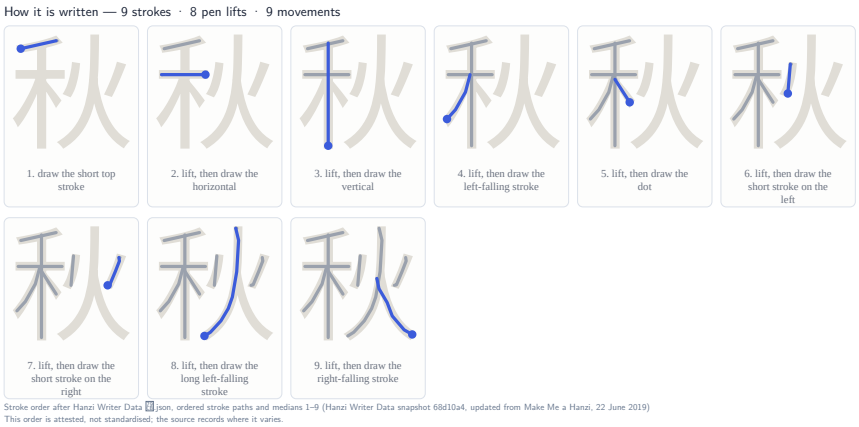
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *Zhōngqiū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  和 火

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hé*, *huǒ*

Script — the grain piece, then 火



How 秋 is written, stroke by stroke

秋

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, the grain piece, five strokes, as on the left of 和: a short stroke falling to the left at the top, a bar, a vertical down through it, a stroke falling to the left from the crossing, and a dot to the right.

The right piece, 火, four strokes, as you wrote it: a short stroke on the left, a short stroke on the right falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the left and a long stroke falling to the right.

5 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 秋, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 秋? (**Nine.**) Where have you met the left piece? (**On the left of 和.**) What is the right piece? (火.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 秋, pinned stroke paths and medians.

342.4 期间 (qījiān) — period (during which); during

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to enjoy the moon, then the Mandarin for the Mid-Autumn Festival.

You'll want to know: 期间

期间 — *qījiān* — "period (during which); during".

中秋期间他给家人买了月饼 *Zhōngqiū qījiān tā gěi jiārén mǎi le yuèbǐng* — Over the moon festival he bought mooncakes for his family.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

期间 (*qījiān*) is built from 期 'a set time' and 间 'between', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gi* and *kean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the second under an older form of the character and glosses it 'a gap'. Middle Chinese *gi* would regularly give qí; the level tone of qī is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qījiān*
- *Say it: qījiān*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngqiū qījiān tā gěi jiārén mǎi le yuèbǐng* — Over the moon festival he bought mooncakes for his family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to enjoy the moon, then the Mandarin for the Mid-Autumn Festival, then say *qījiān* again

Before you move on

What does 期间 mean? ("Period (during which); during".) Say it once more.

342.5 guìhuā — osmanthus flowers

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the Mid-Autumn Festival, then the Mandarin for the time during an event.

You'll want to know: guìhuā

guìhuā — "osmanthus flowers".

qiūtiān de shíhou guìhuā kāi le — In the autumn the osmanthus came into flower.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guìhuā is built from *guì* and 花 'a flower', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwejH* and *xwae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which describes the first as a tree that grows in groves and stays green in winter and summer.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: guìhuā*
- *Say it: guìhuā*, once more
- *Say it: qiūtiān de shíhou guìhuā kāi le* — In the autumn the osmanthus came into flower.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the Mid-Autumn Festival, then the Mandarin for the time during an event, then say *guìhuā* again

Before you move on

What does guìhuā mean? ("Osmanthus flowers".) Say it once more.

342.6 jiāxiāng — hometown; native place

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the time during an event, then the Mandarin for sweet osmanthus flowers.

You'll want to know: jiāxiāng

jiāxiāng — "hometown; native place".

Zhōngqiū de wǎnshang wǒ hěn xiǎng jiāxiāng — On the night of the moon festival I miss home very much.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāxiāng is built from 家 'a home' and *xiāng* 'a village', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *xjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a village community'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāxiāng*
- *Say it: jiāxiāng*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngqiū de wǎnshang wǒ hěn xiǎng jiāxiāng* — On the night of the moon festival I miss home very much.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the time during an event, then the Mandarin for sweet osmanthus flowers, then say *jiāxiāng* again

Before you move on

What does jiāxiāng mean? ("Hometown; native place".) Say it once more.

Chapter 343

Far from Home

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about moonlight, years apart, what is in my heart, good wishes and sharing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 343: I can talk about moonlight, years apart, what is in my heart, good wishes and sharing.*

343.1 yuèguāng — moonlight

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sweet osmanthus flowers, then the Mandarin for one's native place.

You'll want to know: yuèguāng

yuèguāng — "moonlight".

> *jīntiān wǎnshang de yuèguāng hěn hǎo* — The moonlight is lovely tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuèguāng is built from 月 'the moon' and *guāng* 'light', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwot* and *kwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuèguāng*
- *Say it: yuèguāng*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǎnshang de yuèguāng hěn hǎo* — The moonlight is lovely tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sweet osmanthus flowers, then the Mandarin for one's native place, then say *yuèguāng* again

Before you move on

What does yuèguāng mean? ("Moonlight".) Say it once more.

343.2 多年 (duōnián) — for many years

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's native place, then the Mandarin for bright moonlight.

You'll want to know: 多年

多年 — *duōnián* — "for many years".

我们多年没有一起过中秋了 *wǒmen duōnián méiyǒu yìqǐ guò Zhōngqiū le* — We haven't spent the moon festival together for years.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

多年 (*duōnián*) is built from 多 'many' and 年 'a year', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ta* and *nen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'many'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: duōnián*
- *Say it: duōnián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen duōnián méiyǒu yìqǐ guò Zhōngqiū le* — We haven't spent the moon festival together for years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's native place, then the Mandarin for bright moonlight, then say *duōnián* again

Before you move on

What does 多年 mean? ("For many years".) Say it once more.

343.3 心中 (xīnzhōng) — in one's heart

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bright moonlight, then the Mandarin for for many years now.

You'll want to know: 心中

心中 — *xīnzhōng* — "in one's heart".

在我心中这是最好的中秋 *zài wǒ xīnzhōng zhè shì zuì hǎo de Zhōngqiū* — To my mind, this is the best moon festival ever.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心中 (*xīnzhōng*) is built from 心 'the heart' and 中 'the middle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *trjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnzhōng*
- *Say it: xīnzhōng*, once more

- *Say it: zài wǒ xīnzhōng zhè shì zuì hǎo de Zhōngqiū* — To my mind, this is the best moon festival ever.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bright moonlight, then the Mandarin for for many years now, then say *xīnzhōng* again

Before you move on

What does 心中 mean? ("In one's heart".) Say it once more.

343.4 zhùfú — blessing; good wishes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for for many years now, then the Mandarin for deep in one's heart.

You'll want to know: zhùfú

zhùfú — "blessing; good wishes".

Zhōngqiū nà tiān wǒ shōudào le péngyou de zhùfú — On the day of the moon festival I got good wishes from my friends.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhùfú is built from 祝 'to bless' and *fú* 'good fortune', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuwH* and *pjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'virtue' and 'divine help'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhùfú*
- *Say it: zhùfú*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngqiū nà tiān wǒ shōudào le péngyou de zhùfú* — On the day of the moon festival I got good wishes from my friends.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for for many years now, then the Mandarin for deep in one's heart, then say *zhùfú* again

Before you move on

What does zhùfú mean? ("Blessing; good wishes".) Say it once more.

343.5 fēnxiǎng — to share

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for deep in one's heart, then the Mandarin for good wishes sent to someone.

You'll want to know: fēnxiǎng

fēnxiǎng — "to share".

wǒ hé tóngshì fēnxiǎng le wǒ de yuèbǐng — I shared my mooncakes with my colleagues.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēnxiǎng is built from *fēn* 'to divide' and *xiǎng* 'to offer', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjun* and *xjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hand out' and lists the second under an older spelling, 'to offer up'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēnxiǎng*
- *Say it: fēnxiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hé tóngshì fēnxiǎng le wǒ de yuèbǐng* — I shared my mooncakes with my colleagues.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for deep in one's heart, then the Mandarin for good wishes sent to someone, then say *fēnxiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does fēnxiǎng mean? ("To share".) Say it once more.

Chapter 344

Keeping Memories

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I kept something, talk about memories, the past and a photo album, and say I will never forget.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 344: I can say I kept something, talk about memories, the past and a photo album, and say I will never forget.*

344.1 bǎocún — to keep; to save

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for good wishes sent to someone, then the Mandarin for to share good things.

You'll want to know: bǎocún

bǎocún — "to keep; to save".

> *tā de xìn wǒ dōu bǎocún zài shūfáng lǐ* — I've kept all his letters in the study.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎocún is built from *bǎo* and *cún*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *dzwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to keep safe' and the second 'to be there'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎocún*
- *Say it: bǎocún*, once more
- *Say it: tā de xìn wǒ dōu bǎocún zài shūfáng lǐ* — I've kept all his letters in the study.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for good wishes sent to someone, then the Mandarin for to share good things, then say *bǎocún* again

Before you move on

What does bǎocún mean? ("To keep; to save".) Say it once more.

344.2 jìyì — memory

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to share good things, then the Mandarin for to keep something safe.

You'll want to know: jìyì

jìyì — "memory".

nà shì wǒ zuì hǎo de jìyì — That's my best memory.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìyì is built from *jì* and *yì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kiH* and *'ik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to record' and the second 'to think of'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìyì*
- *Say it: jìyì*, once more
- *Say it: nà shì wǒ zuì hǎo de jìyì* — That's my best memory.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to share good things, then the Mandarin for to keep something safe, then say *jìyì* again

Before you move on

What does jìyì mean? ("Memory".) Say it once more.

344.3 wǎngshì — past events; things of the past

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep something safe, then the Mandarin for a memory of the past.

You'll want to know: wǎngshì

wǎngshì — "past events; things of the past".

nà tiān wǎnshang yéye hé wǒmen shuōqǐ le wǎngshì — That evening my grandpa talked to us about the old days.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǎngshì is built from *wǎng* 'to go' and 事 'a matter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwangX* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎngshì*
- *Say it: wǎngshì*, once more
- *Say it: nà tiān wǎnshang yéye hé wǒmen shuōqǐ le wǎngshì* — That evening my grandpa talked to us about the old days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep something safe, then the Mandarin for a memory of the past, then say *wǎngshì* again

Before you move on

What does wǎngshì mean? ("Past events; things of the past".) Say it once more.

344.4 xiàngcè — photo album

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a memory of the past, then the Mandarin for past events.

You'll want to know: xiàngcè

xiàngcè — "photo album".

wǒ zài xiàngcè lǐ kàndào le xiǎoshíhou de zhàopiàn — In the album I came across photos of myself as a child.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàngcè is built from *xiàng* 'a likeness' and *cè* 'a volume', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjangH* and *tsrheak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to look at' and the second 'bound bamboo slips'. The sense 'a photograph' for the first is modern.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàngcè*
- *Say it: xiàngcè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài xiàngcè lǐ kàndào le xiǎoshíhou de zhàopiàn* — In the album I came across photos of myself as a child.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a memory of the past, then the Mandarin for past events, then say *xiàngcè* again

Before you move on

What does xiàngcè mean? ("Photo album".) Say it once more.

344.5 yǒngyuǎn — forever

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for past events, then the Mandarin for a photo album.

You'll want to know: yǒngyuǎn

yǒngyuǎn — "forever".

> *wǒ huì yǒngyuǎn jìde nàge Zhōngqiū* — I'll always remember that moon festival.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: yǒng is said with a rising tone before yuǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒngyuǎn is built from *yǒng* and *yuǎn* 'far', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwaengX* and *hjwonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'long' and the second 'distant'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒngyuǎn*
- *Say it: yǒngyuǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ huì yǒngyuǎn jìde nàge Zhōngqiū* — I'll always remember that moon festival.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for past events, then the Mandarin for a photo album, then say *yǒngyuǎn* again

Before you move on

What does yǒngyuǎn mean? ("Forever".) Say it once more.

Chapter 345

Looking Back

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what people say about the past, say what happened from then on, ask about origins and keep in touch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 345: I can say what people say about the past, say what happened from then on, ask about origins and keep in touch.*

345.1 jùshuō — it is said that; reportedly

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a photo album, then the Mandarin for forever and ever.

You'll want to know: jùshuō

jùshuō — "it is said that; reportedly".

> *jùshuō zhège chuánshuō yǒu liǎngqiān nián le* — They say this legend is two thousand years old.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jùshuō is built from *jù* 'to rely on' and 说 'to say', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjoH* and *sywet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to lean on' and 'to cite'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: jùshuō*
- *Say it: jùshuō*, once more
- *Say it: jùshuō zhège chuánshuō yǒu liǎngqiān nián le* — They say this legend is two thousand years old.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a photo album, then the Mandarin for forever and ever, then say *jùshuō* again

Before you move on

What does jùshuō mean? ("It is said that; reportedly".) Say it once more.

345.2 cóngcǐ — from then on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for forever and ever, then the Mandarin for reportedly.

You'll want to know: cóngcǐ

cóngcǐ — "from then on".

cóngcǐ wángzǐ hé gōngzhǔ zhù zài yìqǐ — From then on the prince and the princess lived together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cóngcǐ is built from 从 'from' and *cǐ* 'this', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjowng* and *tshjeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to follow' and the second with a word for 'to stop'; the sense 'this' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: cóngcǐ*
- *Say it: cóngcǐ*, once more
- *Say it: cóngcǐ wángzǐ hé gōngzhǔ zhù zài yìqǐ* — From then on the prince and the princess lived together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for forever and ever, then the Mandarin for reportedly, then say *cóngcǐ* again

Before you move on

What does cóngcǐ mean? ("From then on".) Say it once more.

345.3 qǐyuán — origin

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for reportedly, then the Mandarin for from then on.

You'll want to know: qǐyuán

qǐyuán — "origin".

nǐ zhīdào Chūnjié de qǐyuán ma — Do you know how the lunar new year began?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qǐyuán is built from 起 'to rise' and *yuán* 'a source', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khiX* and *ngjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says of the second that the head of a river is called so.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐyuán*
- *Say it: qǐyuán*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zhīdào Chūnjié de qǐyuán ma* — Do you know how the lunar new year began?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for reportedly, then the Mandarin for from then on, then say *qǐyuán* again

Before you move on

What does qǐyuán mean? ("Origin".) Say it once more.

345.4 wǎngyǒu — online friend

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for from then on, then the Mandarin for the origin of a custom.

You'll want to know: wǎngyǒu

wǎngyǒu — "online friend".

wǒ hé wǒ de wǎngyǒu jiànmiàn le — I met my online friend in person.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: wǎng is said with a rising tone before yǒu, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǎngyǒu is built from 网 'a net' and *yǒu* 'a friend', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjangX* and *hjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a net for fish or game'. The internet sense is modern.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎngyǒu*
- *Say it: wǎngyǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hé wǒ de wǎngyǒu jiànmiàn le* — I met my online friend in person.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for from then on, then the Mandarin for the origin of a custom, then say *wǎngyǒu* again

Before you move on

What does wǎngyǒu mean? ("Online friend".) Say it once more.

345.5 yóubiān — postcode

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the origin of a custom, then the Mandarin for an online friend.

You'll want to know: yóubiān

yóubiān — "postcode".

nǐ jiā de yóubiān shì duōshao — What's your postcode?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóubiān is built from *yóu* 'the post' and *biān* 'to arrange', a short form of a longer name. Both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuw* and *pjien* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which calls the first a lodge on the border; the dictionary lists the second under *pen* and *pjien*, both glossed 'to put in order'.

What you've built

One more word for telling what happened.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóubiān*
- *Say it: yóubiān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ jiā de yóubiān shì duōshao* — What's your postcode?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the origin of a custom, then the Mandarin for an online friend, then say *yóubiān* again

Before you move on

What does yóubiān mean? ("Postcode".) Say it once more.

345.6 Looking back: from Mooncakes to Looking Back

Say the Mandarin for sweet bean paste and a mooncake.

Your turn

- *Say it:* sweet bean paste, a mooncake, the filling of a dumpling, to taste food with care, trade in a shop
- *Say it:* to enjoy the moon, the Mid-Autumn Festival, the time during an event, sweet osmanthus flowers, one's native place
- *Say it:* bright moonlight, for many years now, deep in one's heart, good wishes sent to someone, to share good things
- *Say it:* to keep something safe, a memory of the past, past events, a photo album, forever and ever
- *Say it:* reportedly, from then on, the origin of a custom, an online friend, a postcode
- *Read it:* 饼 秋 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Sweet bean paste? (*dòushā.*) A mooncake? (月饼, *yuèbǐng.*) The filling of a dumpling? (*xiànr.*) To taste food with care? (*pǐncháng.*) Trade in a shop? (生意, *shēngyi.*) To enjoy the moon? (*shǎngyuè.*) The Mid-Autumn Festival? (中秋, *Zhōngqiū.*) The time during an event? (期间, *qījiān.*) Sweet osmanthus flowers? (*guìhuā.*) One's native place? (*jiāxiāng.*) Bright moonlight? (*yuèguāng.*) For many years now? (多年, *duōnián.*) Deep in one's heart? (心中, *xīnzhōng.*) Good wishes sent to someone? (*zhùfú.*) To share good things? (*fēnxiǎng.*) To keep something safe? (*bǎocún.*) A memory of the past? (*jìyì.*) Past events? (*wǎngshì.*) A photo album? (*xiàngcè.*) Forever and ever? (*yǒngyuǎn.*) Reportedly? (*jùshuō.*) From then on? (*cóngcǐ.*) The origin of a custom? (*qǐyuán.*) An online friend? (*wǎngyǒu.*) A postcode? (*yóubiān.*)

345.7 Looking Back — once more

Say the Mandarin for reportedly and from then on.

Your turn

- *Say it:* reportedly, from then on, the origin of a custom, an online friend, a postcode

Before you move on

Reportedly? (*jùshuō.*) From then on? (*cóngcǐ.*) The origin of a custom? (*qǐyuán.*) An online friend? (*wǎngyǒu.*) A postcode? (*yóubiān.*)

Chapter 346

Thinking It Over

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am thinking something over, give a point of view and say I reckon so.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 346: I can say I am thinking something over, give a point of view and say I reckon so.*

346.1 kǎolǜ — to think something over; to consider

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for online friend, then the Mandarin for postcode.

You'll want to know: kǎolǜ

kǎolǜ — "to think something over; to consider".

> *wǒ zài kǎolǜ qù bu qù Zhōngguó* — I'm thinking over whether to go to China.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kǎolǜ is built from *kǎo* and *lǜ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khawX* and *ljoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to check' and 'to complete', and the second 'to think'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǎolǜ̈*
- *Say it: kǎolǜ̈*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài kǎolǜ̈ qù bu qù Zhōngguó* — I'm thinking over whether to go to China.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for online friend, then the Mandarin for postcode, then say *kǎolǜ̈* again

Before you move on

What does kǎolǜ̈ mean? ("To think something over; to consider".) Say it once more.

346.2 guāndiǎn — point of view; standpoint

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for postcode, then the Mandarin for to think something over.

You'll want to know: guāndiǎn

guāndiǎn — "point of view; standpoint".

wǒ juéde zhège guāndiǎn hěn yǒu yìsi — I think that's an interesting point of view.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guāndiǎn is built from *guān* and 点 'a point', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwan* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to view' and the second 'a dot'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: guāndiǎn*
- *Say it: guāndiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège guāndiǎn hěn yǒu yìsi* — I think that's an interesting point of view.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for postcode, then the Mandarin for to think something over, then say *guāndiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does guāndiǎn mean? ("Point of view; standpoint".) Say it once more.

346.3 感想 (gǎnxiǎng) — impressions afterwards; thoughts

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to think something over, then the Mandarin for a point of view.

You'll want to know: 感想

感想 — *gǎnxiǎng* — "impressions afterwards; thoughts".

> 看了这本书你有什么感想 *kàn le zhè běn shū nǐ yǒu shénme gǎnxiǎng* — What did you make of the book once you'd read it?

Two third tones meet in this word: gǎn is said with a rising tone before xiǎng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

感想 (*gǎnxiǎng*) is built from 感 'to feel' and 想 'to think', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *sjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move' and the

second 'to think'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnxiǎng*
- *Say it: gǎnxiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: kàn le zhè běn shū nǐ yǒu shénme gǎnxiǎng* — What did you make of the book once you'd read it?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to think something over, then the Mandarin for a point of view, then say *gǎnxiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 感想 mean? ("Impressions afterwards; thoughts".) Say it once more.

346.4 以为 (yǐwéi) — to wrongly assume; to take it that (often wrongly)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a point of view, then the Mandarin for your impressions afterwards.

You'll want to know: 以为

以为 — *yǐwéi* — "to wrongly assume; to take it that (often wrongly)".

我以为你不来了 *wǒ yǐwéi nǐ bù lái le* — I thought you weren't coming.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

以为 (*yǐwéi*) is built from 以 'to take' and 为 'to make', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yiX* and *hjwe* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to use' and lists the second as

the everyday spelling of a word glossed 'to make'. How the pair came to mean a belief that turns out wrong is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐwéi*
- *Say it: yǐwéi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǐwéi nǐ bù lái le* — I thought you weren't coming.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a point of view, then the Mandarin for your impressions afterwards, then say *yǐwéi* again

Before you move on

What does 以为 mean? ("To wrongly assume; to take it that (often wrongly)".) Say it once more.

346.5 gūjì — to reckon; to make a rough guess

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for your impressions afterwards, then the Mandarin for to wrongly assume.

You'll want to know: gūjì

gūjì — "to reckon; to make a rough guess".

yīnwèi xiàyǔ suǒyǐ wǒ gūjì tā bú huì lái — It's raining, so I reckon he won't come.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gūjì is built from *gū* and *jì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *kejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a market tax' and the second 'to reckon up'. How the first came to

mean estimating is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gūjì*
- *Say it: gūjì*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi xiàyǔ suǒyǐ wǒ gūjì tā bú huì lái* — It's raining, so I reckon he won't come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for your impressions afterwards, then the Mandarin for to wrongly assume, then say *gūjì* again

Before you move on

What does gūjì mean? ("To reckon; to make a rough guess".) Say it once more.

Chapter 347

What Do You Mean?

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what something means, say an idea is a good one and say I know from experience.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 347: I can ask what something means, say an idea is a good one and say I know from experience.*

347.1 zhǔyi — bright idea; idea of what to do

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wrongly assume, then the Mandarin for to make a rough guess.

You'll want to know: zhǔyi

zhǔyi — "bright idea; idea of what to do".

> *wǒ juéde zhège zhǔyi hěn hǎo* — I think that's a good idea.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔyi is built from *zhǔ* and 意 'intent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuX* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be in charge' and the second 'will'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔyi*
- *Say it: zhǔyi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège zhǔyi hěn hǎo* — I think that's a good idea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wrongly assume, then the Mandarin for to make a rough guess, then say *zhǔyi* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔyi mean? ("Bright idea; idea of what to do".) Say it once more.

347.2 意思 (yìsi) — meaning; what something means

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a rough guess, then the Mandarin for a bright idea.

You'll want to know: 意思

意思 — *yìsi* — "meaning; what something means".

这个字是什么意思 *zhège zì shì shénme yìsi* — What does this character mean?

The new character, in pieces: 思 — nine strokes in two pieces: on top a box with a cross inside it, five strokes; under it 心 *xīn*, the heart, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

意思 (*yìsi*) is built from 意 'intent' and 思 'to think', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'iH* and *si* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'will' and the second 'to think of'.

The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìsi*
- *Say it: yìsi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège zì shì shénme yìsi* — What does this character mean?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a rough guess, then the Mandarin for a bright idea, then say *yìsi* again

Before you move on

What does 意思 mean? ("Meaning; what something means".) Say it once more.

347.3 思 — a box with a cross, over the heart

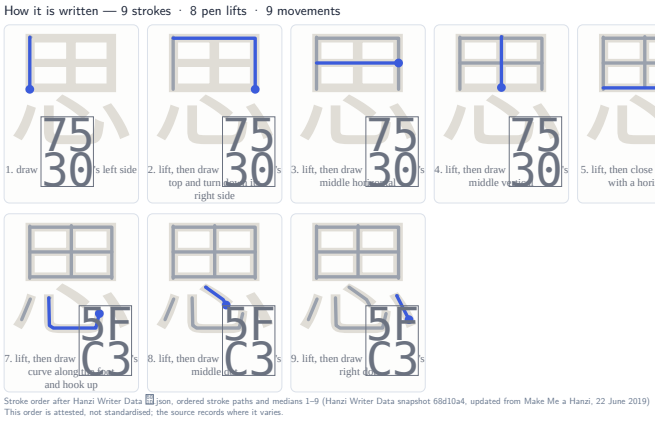
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yìsi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  心 想 意

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xīn*, *xiǎng*, *yì*

Script — a box with a cross, over the heart



How 思 *is written, stroke by stroke*

思

Two pieces, top before bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, a box with a cross inside, five strokes. A short vertical down the left side. A horizontal along the top that turns down the right side. A short horizontal across the middle. A vertical down the middle. Then the bottom horizontal that closes the box.

The bottom piece, 心, four strokes, wider than the box: the left dot, the long curve along the foot that hooks up, the middle dot, the right dot.

5 + 4 = nine, and the last four your hand already knows.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 思, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 思? (**Two**.) Which comes first, the box or the heart? (**The box, on top**.) How many strokes in the box? (**Five**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 思, pinned stroke paths and medians.

347.4 sīkǎo — to think hard; to reflect

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bright idea, then the Mandarin for what something means.

You'll want to know: sīkǎo

sīkǎo — "to think hard; to reflect".

> *tā xǐhuan yí ge rén sīkǎo* — He likes to think things through alone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sīkǎo is built from 思 'to think' and *kǎo* 'to check', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *si* and *khawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to think of' and the second 'to check'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: sīkǎo*
- *Say it: sīkǎo*, once more
- *Say it: tā xǐhuan yí ge rén sīkǎo* — He likes to think things through alone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bright idea, then the Mandarin for what something means, then say *sīkǎo* again

Before you move on

What does sīkǎo mean? ("To think hard; to reflect".) Say it once more.

347.5 yìyì — significance; meaning

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what something means, then the Mandarin for to think hard.

You'll want to know: yìyì

yìyì — "significance; meaning".

wǒ juéde zhège gōngzuò hěn yǒu yìyì — I think this work really matters.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìyì is built from 意 'intent' and *yì* 'right conduct', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'iH* and *ngjeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'will' and the second 'benevolence and right conduct'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìyì*
- *Say it: yìyì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège gōngzuò hěn yǒu yìyì* — I think this work really matters.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what something means, then the Mandarin for to think hard, then say *yìyì* again

Before you move on

What does yìyì mean? ("Significance; meaning".) Say it once more.

347.6 体会 (tǐhuì) — to know from experience; to come to understand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to think hard, then the Mandarin for the significance of something.

You'll want to know: 体会

体会 — *tǐhuì* — "to know from experience; to come to understand".

wǒ néng tǐhuì nǐ de xīnqíng — I know how you feel.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

体会 (*tǐhuì*) is built from 体 'the body' and 会 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the body' and the second 'to come together'. How the pair came to mean knowing from experience is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐhuì*
- *Say it: tǐhuì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ néng tǐhuì nǐ de xīnqíng* — I know how you feel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to think hard, then the Mandarin for the significance of something, then say *tǐhuì* again

Before you move on

What does 体会 mean? ("To know from experience; to come to understand".) Say it once more.

Chapter 348

Talking It Over

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say we are discussing something, talk it over with the other side and say we all agree.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 348: I can say we are discussing something, talk it over with the other side and say we all agree.*

348.1 tǎolùn — to discuss

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the significance of something, then the Mandarin for to know from experience.

You'll want to know: tǎolùn

tǎolùn — "to discuss".

> *wǒmen míngtiān kāihuì tǎolùn zhège wèntí* — We'll discuss this at tomorrow's meeting.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǎolùn is built from *tǎo* and *lùn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thawX* and *lwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to govern' and 'to punish', and the second 'to speak' and 'to discuss'; it also lists the second in the departing tone, the tone of lùn today.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǎolùn*
- *Say it: tǎolùn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen míngtiān kāihuì tǎolùn zhège wèntí* — We'll discuss this at tomorrow's meeting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the significance of something, then the Mandarin for to know from experience, then say *tǎolùn* again

Before you move on

What does tǎolùn mean? ("To discuss".) Say it once more.

348.2 shāngliang — to talk it over together; to consult

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to know from experience, then the Mandarin for to discuss.

You'll want to know: shāngliang

shāngliang — "to talk it over together; to consult".

wǒmen yīnggāi gēn lǎoshī shāngliang — We should talk it over with the teacher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāngliang is built from *shāng* and *liáng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syang* and *ljang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, among other senses, 'to deliberate', and the second 'to measure'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāngliang*
- *Say it: shāngliang*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi gēn lǎoshī shāngliang* — We should talk it over with the teacher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to know from experience, then the Mandarin for to discuss, then say *shāngliang* again

Before you move on

What does shāngliang mean? ("To talk it over together; to consult".) Say it once more.

348.3 zhēnglùn — to argue over a point; to debate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to discuss, then the Mandarin for to talk it over together.

You'll want to know: zhēnglùn

zhēnglùn — "to argue over a point; to debate".

> *tāmen zài zhēnglùn zhège wèntí* — They're arguing over this question.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhēnglùn is built from *zhēng* and *lùn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsreang* and *lwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to compete' and the second 'to discuss'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhēnglùn*
- *Say it: zhēnglùn*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen zài zhēnglùn zhège wèntí* — They're arguing over this question.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to discuss, then the Mandarin for to talk it over together, then say *zhēnglùn* again

Before you move on

What does zhēnglùn mean? ("To argue over a point; to debate".) Say it once more.

348.4 duìfāng — the other side; the other party

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to talk it over together, then the Mandarin for to argue over a point.

You'll want to know: duìfāng

duìfāng — "the other side; the other party".

nǐ yīnggāi tīng duìfāng shuō wán — You should hear the other side out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duìfāng is built from 对 'facing' and *fāng* 'a side', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *twojH* and *pjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to answer' and 'to match', and the second 'the four quarters'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: duìfāng*
- *Say it: duìfāng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yīnggāi tīng duìfāng shuō wán* — You should hear the other side out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to talk it over together, then the Mandarin for to argue over a point, then say *duìfāng* again

Before you move on

What does duìfāng mean? ("The other side; the other party".) Say it once more.

348.5 yízhì — all of one mind; in agreement

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to argue over a point, then the Mandarin for the other party.

You'll want to know: yízhì

yízhì — "all of one mind; in agreement".

dàjiā de yìjiàn hěn yízhì — Everyone was of one mind.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The tone of yī changes here: before a falling tone it is said yí, and the spelling writes the change.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yízhì is built from 一 'one' and *zhì* 'to arrive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *trijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the start of the numbers' and the second 'to arrive'. How the pair came to mean agreement is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yízhì*
- *Say it: yízhì*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā de yìjiàn hěn yízhì* — Everyone was of one mind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to argue over a point, then the Mandarin for the other party, then say *yízhì* again

Before you move on

What does yízhì mean? ("All of one mind; in agreement".) Say it once more.

Chapter 349

Ways of Seeing

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how someone sees a question and talk about ideas and ways of doing things.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 349: I can ask how someone sees a question and talk about ideas and ways of doing things.*

349.1 kàndài — to regard (in a certain way)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the other party, then the Mandarin for all of one mind.

You'll want to know: kàndài

kàndài — "to regard (in a certain way)".

> *nǐ zěnme kàndài zhège wèntí* — How do you view this question?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kàndài is built from 看 and *dài*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khan* and *dojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to view' and the second 'to wait'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kàndài*
- *Say it: kàndài*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zěnme kàndài zhège wèntí* — How do you view this question?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the other party, then the Mandarin for all of one mind, then say *kàndài* again

Before you move on

What does kàndài mean? ("To regard (in a certain way)".) Say it once more.

349.2 想法 (xiǎngfǎ) — idea; way of thinking

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all of one mind, then the Mandarin for to regard.

You'll want to know: 想法

想法 — *xiǎngfǎ* — "idea; way of thinking".

我觉得你的想法很好 *wǒ juéde nǐ de xiǎngfǎ hěn hǎo* — I think your idea is a good one.

The new character, in pieces: 法 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left the water piece, three strokes, as on the left of 汉; on the right 去 *qù*, five strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Two third tones meet in this word: xiǎng is said with a rising tone before fǎ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

想法 (*xiǎngfǎ*) is built from 想 'to think' and 法 'a rule', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjangX* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to think' and the second 'a rule' and 'a norm'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎngfǎ*
- *Say it: xiǎngfǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde nǐ de xiǎngfǎ hěn hǎo* — I think your idea is a good one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all of one mind, then the Mandarin for to regard, then say *xiǎngfǎ* again

Before you move on

What does 想法 mean? ("Idea; way of thinking".) Say it once more.

349.3 法 — the water piece, then qù

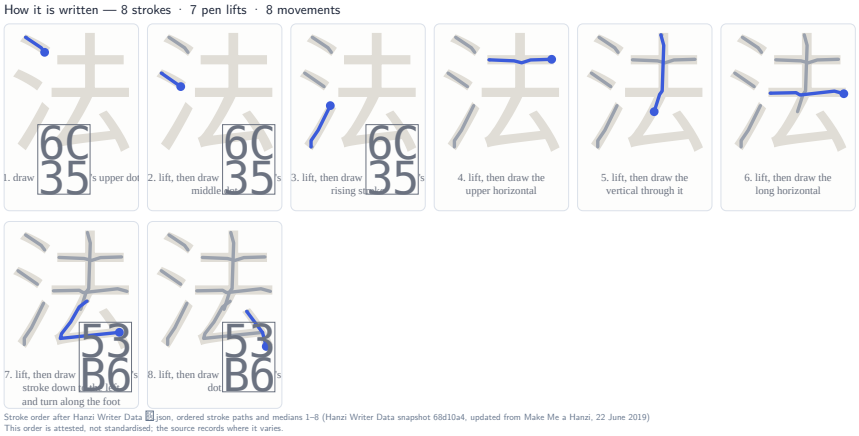
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiǎngfǎ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  去 汉 想

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qù*, *hàn*, *xiǎng*

Script — the water piece, then qù



How 法 is written, stroke by stroke

法

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the water piece, three strokes, as on the left of 汉: a dot, a second dot under it, then a stroke that rises from the bottom left.

The right piece, 去, five strokes: a short horizontal, a vertical down through it, a long horizontal, then a stroke that falls left and turns right, and a dot.

3 + 5 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 法, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 法? (**Two**.) Which character you know has the same left piece? (汉, or 洗.) What is the right piece read? (*qù*.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 法, pinned stroke paths and medians.

349.4 说法 (shuōfa) — version of events; way of putting it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to regard, then the Mandarin for a way of thinking.

You'll want to know: 说法

说法 — *shuōfa* — "version of events; way of putting it".

我觉得这个说法不对 *wǒ juéde zhège shuōfa bú duì* — I don't think that's the right way to put it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

说法 (*shuōfa*) is built from 说 'to say' and 法 'a rule', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sywet* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tell' and the second 'a rule'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuōfa*
- *Say it: shuōfa*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège shuōfa bú duì* — I don't think that's the right way to put it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to regard, then the Mandarin for a way of thinking, then say *shuōfa* again

Before you move on

What does 说法 mean? ("Version of events; way of putting it".) Say it once more.

349.5 做法 (zuòfǎ) — the way something is done; method

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a way of thinking, then the Mandarin for one version of events.

You'll want to know: 做法

做法 — *zuòfǎ* — "the way something is done; method".

我觉得这个做法不好 *wǒ juéde zhège zuòfǎ bù hǎo* — I don't think that's a good way to go about it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

做法 (*zuòfǎ*) is built from 做 'to do' and 法 'a rule'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a rule'. No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòfǎ*
- *Say it: zuòfǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège zuòfǎ bù hǎo* — I don't think that's a good way to go about it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a way of thinking, then the Mandarin for one version of events, then say *zuòfǎ* again

Before you move on

What does 做法 mean? ("The way something is done; method".) Say it once more.

349.6 zhǔzhāng — to argue in favour of; to advocate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one version of events, then the Mandarin for the way something is done.

You'll want to know: zhǔzhāng

zhǔzhāng — "to argue in favour of; to advocate".

tā zhǔzhāng dàjiā yìqǐ qù — He's in favour of everyone going together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔzhāng is built from *zhǔ* and *zhāng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuX* and *trjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be in charge' and the second 'to spread out'. How the pair came to mean arguing for something is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔzhāng*
- *Say it: zhǔzhāng*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhǔzhāng dàjiā yìqǐ qù* — He's in favour of everyone going together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one version of events, then the Mandarin for the way something is done, then say *zhǔzhāng* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔzhāng mean? ("To argue in favour of; to advocate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 350

Facts and Grounds

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what the facts are, what a claim rests on and that it is hard to judge.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 350: I can say what the facts are, what a claim rests on and that it is hard to judge.*

350.1 shìshí — fact

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the way something is done, then the Mandarin for to argue in favour of.

You'll want to know: shìshí

shìshí — "fact".

> *wǒ juéde tā shuō de shì shìshí* — I think what he says is true.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shìshí is built from 事 'a matter' and *shí*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzriH* and *zyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'full' and 'sincere'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìshí*
- *Say it: shìshí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde tā shuō de shì shìshí* — I think what he says is true.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the way something is done, then the Mandarin for to argue in favour of, then say *shìshí* again

Before you move on

What does shìshí mean? ("Fact".) Say it once more.

350.2 zhèngmíng — to prove

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to argue in favour of, then the Mandarin for a fact.

You'll want to know: zhèngmíng

zhèngmíng — "to prove".

nǐ néng zhèngmíng nǐ shuō de huà ma — Can you prove what you say?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhèngmíng is built from *zhèng* and 明 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyingH* and *mjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to verify' and the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngmíng*
- *Say it: zhèngmíng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ néng zhèngmíng nǐ shuō de huà ma* — Can you prove what you say?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to argue in favour of, then the Mandarin for a fact, then say *zhèngmíng* again

Before you move on

What does zhèngmíng mean? ("To prove".) Say it once more.

350.3 gēnjù — basis; what something rests on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a fact, then the Mandarin for to prove.

You'll want to know: gēnjù

gēnjù — "basis; what something rests on".

> *yīnwèi méiyǒu gēnjù suǒyǐ wǒ bù xiāngxìn* — There's nothing to back it up, so I don't believe it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēnjù is built from *gēn* and *jù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kon* and *kjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a root' and the second 'to rely on'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēnjù*
- *Say it: gēnjù*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi méiyǒu gēnjù suǒyǐ wǒ bù xiāngxìn* — There's nothing to back it up, so I don't believe it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a fact, then the Mandarin for to prove, then say *gēnjù* again

Before you move on

What does gēnjù mean? ("Basis; what something rests on".) Say it once more.

350.4 pànduàn — to make a judgement; to judge

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to prove, then the Mandarin for a basis for a claim.

You'll want to know: pànduàn

pànduàn — "to make a judgement; to judge".

wǒ bù néng pànduàn tā shuō de shì bu shì shìshí — I can't judge whether what he says is true.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pànduàn is built from *pàn* and *duàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phanH* and *dwanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to split' and 'to divide', and the second 'to cut off'; it also lists the second in the departing tone, glossed 'to decide'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: pànduàn*
- *Say it: pànduàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù néng pànduàn tā shuō de shì bu shì shìshí* — I can't judge whether what he says is true.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to prove, then the Mandarin for a basis for a claim, then say *pànduàn* again

Before you move on

What does pànduàn mean? ("To make a judgement; to judge".) Say it once more.

350.5 quèshí — indeed; it is true that

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a basis for a claim, then the Mandarin for to make a judgement.

You'll want to know: quèshí

quèshí — "indeed; it is true that".

tā shuō de quèshí shì shìshí — What he said really is a fact.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

quèshí is built from *què* and *shí*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaewk* and *zyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'firm' and the second 'full' and 'sincere'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: quèshí*
- *Say it: quèshí*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō de quèshí shì shìshí* — What he said really is a fact.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a basis for a claim, then the Mandarin for to make a judgement, then say *quèshí* again

Before you move on

What does quèshí mean? ("Indeed; it is true that".) Say it once more.

Chapter 351

That Makes Sense

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is in the right, analyse a problem, and talk about ideals and states of mind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 351: I can say someone is in the right, analyse a problem, and talk about ideals and states of mind.*

351.1 fēnxī — to analyse

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a judgement, then the Mandarin for indeed.

You'll want to know: fēnxī

fēnxī — "to analyse".

> *wǒmen yīnggāi xiān fēnxī wèntí* — We should analyse the problem first.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēnxī is built from *fēn* and *xī*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjun* and *sek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to share out' and the second 'to split'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēnxī*
- *Say it: fēnxī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi xiān fēnxī wèntí* — We should analyse the problem first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a judgement, then the Mandarin for indeed, then say *fēnxī* again

Before you move on

What does fēnxī mean? ("To analyse".) Say it once more.

351.2 有理 (yǒulǐ) — reasonable; in the right

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for indeed, then the Mandarin for to analyse.

You'll want to know: 有理

有理 — *yǒulǐ* — "reasonable; in the right".

我觉得你说得有理 *wǒ juéde nǐ shuō de yǒulǐ* — I think you've got a point.

The new character, in pieces: 理 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left the jade piece, four strokes, three bars and a vertical, the last bar rising to the right; on the right 里 *lǐ*, seven strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Two third tones meet in this word: yǒu is said with a rising tone before lǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

有理 (*yǒulǐ*) is built from 有 'to have' and 理 'order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to put in order' and, quoting an older dictionary, 'to work jade'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒulǐ*
- *Say it: yǒulǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde nǐ shuō de yǒulǐ* — I think you've got a point.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for indeed, then the Mandarin for to analyse, then say *yǒulǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 有理 mean? ("Reasonable; in the right".) Say it once more.

351.3 理 — the jade piece, then lǐ

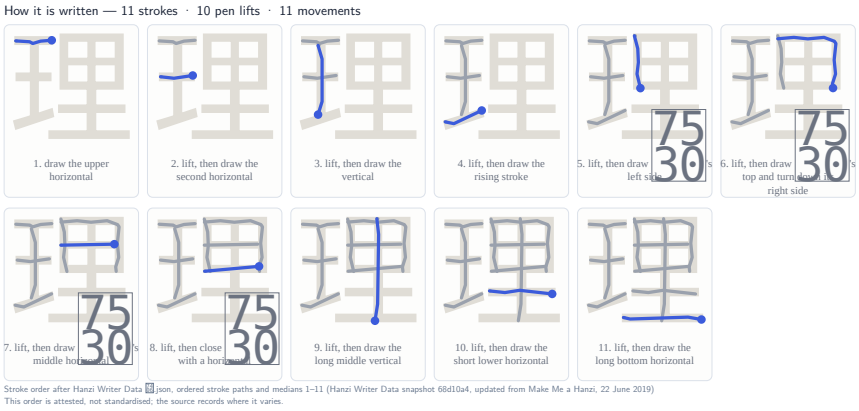
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yǒulǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  里 有

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lǐ*, *yǒu*

Script — the jade piece, then lǐ



How 理 *is written, stroke by stroke*

理

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the jade piece, four strokes, narrow: a horizontal, a second horizontal, a vertical down through them, then a bar at the foot that rises to the right.

The right piece, 里, seven strokes: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, a horizontal across the middle, a horizontal closing the box, a vertical down through the middle, a short horizontal, then the long horizontal at the foot.

4 + 7 = eleven, and the last seven your hand already knows.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 理, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 理? (**Two.**) What is the right piece read? (*lǐ*, as in 里.) How does the jade piece end? (**With a bar that rises to the right.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 理, pinned stroke paths and medians.

351.4 jiǎnglǐ — to be reasonable; to listen to reason

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to analyse, then the Mandarin for in the right in an argument.

You'll want to know: jiǎnglǐ

jiǎnglǐ — "to be reasonable; to listen to reason".

zhège rén bù jiǎnglǐ — This man won't listen to reason.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: jiǎng is said with a rising tone before lǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎnglǐ is built from *jiǎng* and 理 'order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngX* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tell' and 'to discuss', and the second 'to put in order'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎnglǐ*
- *Say it: jiǎnglǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhège rén bù jiǎnglǐ* — This man won't listen to reason.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to analyse, then the Mandarin for in the right in an argument, then say *jiǎnglǐ* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎnglǐ mean? ("To be reasonable; to listen to reason".) Say it once more.

351.5 理想 (lǐxiǎng) — ideal; aspiration

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in the right in an argument, then the Mandarin for to listen to reason.

You'll want to know: 理想

理想 — *lǐxiǎng* — "ideal; aspiration".

我的理想是当医生 *wǒ de lǐxiǎng shì dāng yīshēng* — My dream is to be a doctor.

Two third tones meet in this word: lǐ is said with a rising tone before xiǎng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

理想 (*lǐxiǎng*) is built from 理 'order' and 想 'to think', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *liX* and *sjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to put in order' and the second 'to think'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐxiǎng*
- *Say it: lǐxiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de lǐxiǎng shì dāng yīshēng* — My dream is to be a doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in the right in an argument, then the Mandarin for to listen to reason, then say *lǐxiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 理想 mean? ("Ideal; aspiration".) Say it once more.

351.6 心理 (xīnlǐ) — state of mind; psychology

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to listen to reason, then the Mandarin for an ideal to live up to.

You'll want to know: 心理

心理 — *xīnlǐ* — "state of mind; psychology".

wǒ juéde zhè shì xīnlǐ wèntí — I think it's all in the mind.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心理 (*xīnlǐ*) is built from 心 'the heart' and 理 'order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to put in order'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnlǐ*
- *Say it: xīnlǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhè shì xīnlǐ wèntí* — I think it's all in the mind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to listen to reason, then the Mandarin for an ideal to live up to, then say *xīnlǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 心理 mean? ("State of mind; psychology".) Say it once more.

351.7 Looking back: from Thinking It Over to That Makes Sense

Say the Mandarin for to think something over and a point of view.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to think something over, a point of view, your impressions afterwards, to wrongly assume, to make a rough guess
- *Say it:* a bright idea, what something means, to think hard, the significance of something, to know from experience
- *Say it:* to discuss, to talk it over together, to argue over a point, the other party, all of one mind
- *Say it:* to regard, a way of thinking, one version of events, the way something is done, to argue in favour of
- *Say it:* a fact, to prove, a basis for a claim, to make a judgement, indeed
- *Say it:* to analyse, in the right in an argument, to listen to reason, an ideal to live up to, a person's state of mind
- *Read it:* 思 法 理 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To think something over? (*kǎolǜ.*) A point of view? (*guāndiǎn.*) Your impressions afterwards? (感想, *gǎnxiǎng.*) To wrongly assume? (以为, *yǐwéi.*) To make a rough guess? (*gūjì.*) A bright idea? (*zhǔyi.*) What something means? (意思, *yìsi.*) To think hard? (*sīkǎo.*) The significance of something? (*yìyì.*) To know from experience? (体会, *tǐhuì.*) To discuss? (*tǎolùn.*) To talk it over together? (*shāngliang.*) To argue over a point? (*zhēnglùn.*) The other party? (*duìfāng.*) All of one mind? (*yízhì.*) To regard? (*kàndài.*) A way of thinking? (想法, *xiǎngfǎ.*) One version of events? (说法, *shuōfa.*) The way something is done? (做法, *zuòfǎ.*) To argue in favour of? (*zhǔzhāng.*) A fact? (*shìshí.*) To prove? (*zhèngmíng.*) A basis for a claim? (*gēnjù.*) To make a judgement?

(*pànduàn.*) Indeed? (*quèshí.*) To analyse? (*fēnxī.*) In the right in an argument? (有理, *yǒulǐ.*) To listen to reason? (*jiǎnglǐ.*) An ideal to live up to? (理想, *lǐxiǎng.*) A person's state of mind? (心理, *xīnlǐ.*)

Chapter 352

Same Here

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I feel the same, give my approval and say what I really meant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 352: I can say I feel the same, give my approval and say what I really meant.*

352.1 同感 (tónggǎn) — the same feeling

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an ideal to live up to, then the Mandarin for a person's state of mind.

You'll want to know: 同感

同感 — *tónggǎn* — "the same feeling".

> 我也有同感 *wǒ yě yǒu tónggǎn* — I feel the same.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

同感 (*tónggǎn*) is built from 同 'the same' and 感 'to feel', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwng* and *komX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'equal' and 'together', and the second 'to move'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tónggǎn*
- *Say it: tónggǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yě yǒu tónggǎn* — I feel the same.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an ideal to live up to, then the Mandarin for a person's state of mind, then say *tónggǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 同感 mean? ("The same feeling".) Say it once more.

352.2 kěndìng — for sure; without doubt

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a person's state of mind, then the Mandarin for the same feeling.

You'll want to know: kěndìng

kěndìng — "for sure; without doubt".

wǒ juéde tā kěndìng huì tóngyì — I'm sure he'll agree.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kěndìng is built from two parts, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khongX* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and the second 'to settle'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěndìng*
- *Say it: kěndìng*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ juéde tā kěndìng huì tóngyì* — I'm sure he'll agree.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a person's state of mind, then the Mandarin for the same feeling, then say *kěndìng* again

Before you move on

What does kěndìng mean? ("For sure; without doubt".) Say it once more.

352.3 rènkě — to give your approval; to accept as good

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the same feeling, then the Mandarin for for sure.

You'll want to know: rènkě

rènkě — "to give your approval; to accept as good".

dàjiā dōu rènkě tā de xiǎngfǎ — Everyone approved of his idea.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rènkě is built from *rèn* and *kě*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyinH* and *khaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to recognize' and the second 'to permit'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: rènkě*
- *Say it: rènkě*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu rènkě tā de xiǎngfǎ* — Everyone approved of his idea.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the same feeling, then the Mandarin for for sure, then say *rènkě* again

Before you move on

What does rènkě mean? ("To give your approval; to accept as good".) Say it once more.

352.4 本意 (běnyì) — what one really meant; original intention

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for for sure, then the Mandarin for to give your approval.

You'll want to know: 本意

本意 — *běnyì* — "what one really meant; original intention".

这不是我的本意 *zhè bú shì wǒ de běnyì* — That's not what I meant.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

本意 (*běnyì*) is built from 本 'the root' and 意 'intent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwonX* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the root, as against the branches' and the second 'will'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: běnyì*
- *Say it: běnyì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè bú shì wǒ de běnyì* — That's not what I meant.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for for sure, then the Mandarin for to give your approval, then say *běnyì* again

Before you move on

What does 本意 mean? ("What one really meant; original intention".) Say it once more.

352.5 biǎoshì — to make your view known; to express

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give your approval, then the Mandarin for what one really meant.

You'll want to know: biǎoshì

biǎoshì — "to make your view known; to express".

yīnwèi dàjiā dōu tóngyì suǒyǐ tā yě biǎoshì tóngyì — Everyone agreed, so he said he agreed too.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biǎoshì is built from *biǎo* and *shì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjewX* and *zyijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to make clear' and the second 'to hand down a sign'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: biǎoshì*
- *Say it: biǎoshì*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi dàjiā dōu tóngyì suǒyǐ tā yě biǎoshì tóngyì* — Everyone agreed, so he said he agreed too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give your approval, then the Mandarin for what one really meant, then say *biǎoshì* again

Before you move on

What does biǎoshì mean? ("To make your view known; to express".) Say it once more.

Chapter 353

You've Got a Point

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone has a point, talk someone round and say something is not necessarily so.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 353: I can say someone has a point, talk someone round and say something is not necessarily so.*

353.1 shuōfú — to talk someone round; to persuade

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what one really meant, then the Mandarin for to make your view known.

You'll want to know: shuōfú

shuōfú — "to talk someone round; to persuade".

wǒ juéde nǐ néng shuōfú tā — I think you can talk him round.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuōfú is built from 说 'to say' and *fú*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sywet* and *bjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tell' and the second 'to serve' and 'clothes'. How the pair came to mean persuading is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuōfú*
- *Say it: shuōfú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde nǐ néng shuōfú tā* — I think you can talk him round.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what one really meant, then the Mandarin for to make your view known, then say *shuōfú* again

Before you move on

What does shuōfú mean? ("To talk someone round; to persuade".) Say it once more.

353.2 道理 (dàoli) — sense; the reason something makes sense

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make your view known, then the Mandarin for to talk someone round.

You'll want to know: 道理

道理 — *dàoli* — "sense; the reason something makes sense".

你说得很有道理 *nǐ shuō de hěn yǒu dàoli* — You've got a point there.

The new character, in pieces: 道 — twelve strokes in two pieces: first a head piece of nine, two short strokes, a bar, a short left-falling stroke and a narrow box with two bars inside; then the walking piece of 这 and 过, three strokes, written last. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

道理 (*dàoli*) is built from 道 'a way' and 理 'order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dawX* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'a principle' and 'a road', and the second 'to put in order'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàoli*
- *Say it: dàoli*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shuō de hěn yǒu dàoli* — You've got a point there.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make your view known, then the Mandarin for to talk someone round, then say *dàoli* again

Before you move on

What does 道理 mean? ("Sense; the reason something makes sense".) Say it once more.

353.3 道 — a head piece, then the walking piece

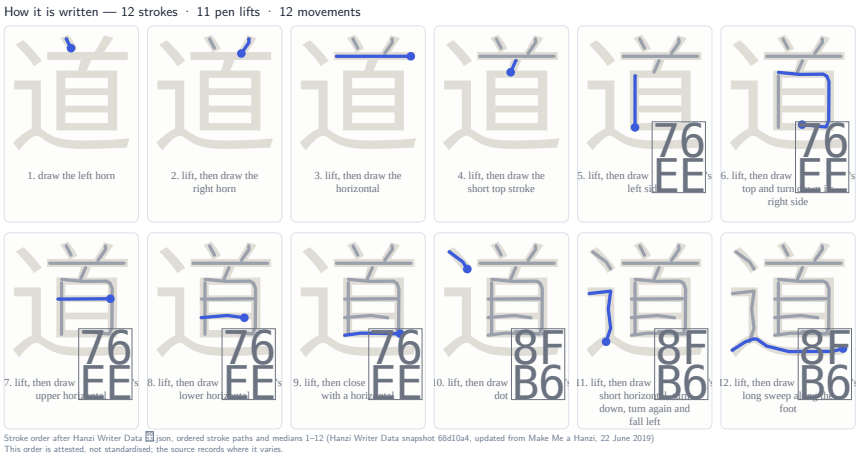
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dàoli* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  这 过 理

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhè*, *guò*, *lǐ*

Script — a head piece, then the walking piece



How 道 *is written, stroke by stroke*

道

Two pieces: the head piece first, the walking piece last, although it sits on the left and along the foot. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The head piece, nine strokes. A short stroke falling to the right and a short stroke falling to the left, like two horns. A horizontal under them. A short left-falling stroke. Then a narrow box: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, two short horizontals inside and one closing the foot.

The walking piece, three strokes, as in 这: a dot, a stroke that zigzags down, then a long sweep along the foot to the right, under the head piece.

9 + 3 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 道, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 道? (**Two.**) Which is written first? (**The head piece**, though the walking piece is on the left.) Where have you written the walking piece? (**In 这 and 过.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 道, pinned stroke paths and medians.

353.4 不见得 (bújiànde) — not necessarily

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to talk someone round, then the Mandarin for the sense something makes.

You'll want to know: 不见得

不见得 — *bújiànde* — "not necessarily".

guì de dōngxi bújiànde hǎo — Expensive things aren't necessarily good.

The tone of bù changes here: before a falling tone it is said bú, and the spelling writes the change.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不见得 (*bújiànde*) is built from 不 'not', 见 'to see' and 得 'to get', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut*, *kenH* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as another word for not, the second 'to see' and the third 'gain'. How the three came to mean not necessarily is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bújiànde*
- *Say it: bújiànde*, once more
- *Say it: guì de dōngxi bújiànde hǎo* — Expensive things aren't necessarily good.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to talk someone round, then the Mandarin for the sense something makes, then say *bújiànde* again

Before you move on

What does 不见得 mean? ("Not necessarily".) Say it once more.

353.5 fǎnbó — to argue back; to refute

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the sense something makes, then the Mandarin for not necessarily.

You'll want to know: fǎnbó

fǎnbó — "to argue back; to refute".

yīnwèi tā shuō de hěn yǒu dàoli suǒyǐ wǒ méiyǒu fǎnbó — He had a point, so I didn't argue back.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fǎnbó is built from *fǎn* and *bó*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjonX* and *paewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn over' and the second 'a horse of mixed colour'. How the pair came to mean arguing back is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fǎnbó*
- *Say it: fǎnbó*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi tā shuō de hěn yǒu dàoli suǒyǐ wǒ méiyǒu fǎnbó* — He had a point, so I didn't argue back.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the sense something makes, then the Mandarin for not necessarily, then say *fǎnbó* again

Before you move on

What does fǎnbó mean? ("To argue back; to refute".) Say it once more.

353.6 rèntóng — to share someone's view; to identify with

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for not necessarily, then the Mandarin for to argue back.

You'll want to know: rèntóng

rèntóng — "to share someone's view; to identify with".

wǒ hěn rèntóng nǐ de kànfǎ — I really share your view.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rèntóng is built from *rèn* and 同 'the same', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyinH* and *duwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to recognize' and the second 'equal'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: rèntóng*
- *Say it: rèntóng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn rèntóng nǐ de kànfǎ* — I really share your view.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for not necessarily, then the Mandarin for to argue back, then say *rèntóng* again

Before you move on

What does rèntóng mean? ("To share someone's view; to identify with".) Say it once more.

Chapter 354

Changing the Subject

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a topic, put a question in class and say what something is about.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 354: I can name a topic, put a question in class and say what something is about.*

354.1 tíwèn — to put a question (in class or a meeting)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to argue back, then the Mandarin for to share someone's view.

You'll want to know: tíwèn

tíwèn — "to put a question (in class or a meeting)".

> *yǒu wèntí zuìhǎo xiàkè yǐhòu tíwèn* — If you have a question, it's best to ask after class.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tíwèn is built from *tí* and 问 'to ask', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dej* and *mjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to carry by the hand' and the second 'to inquire'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíwèn*
- *Say it: tíwèn*, once more
- *Say it: yǒu wèntí zuìhǎo xiàkè yǐhòu tíwèn* — If you have a question, it's best to ask after class.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to argue back, then the Mandarin for to share someone's view, then say *tíwèn* again

Before you move on

What does tíwèn mean? ("To put a question (in class or a meeting)".) Say it once more.

354.2 话题 (huàtí) — topic of conversation

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to share someone's view, then the Mandarin for to put a question.

You'll want to know: 话题

话题 — *huàtí* — "topic of conversation".

我觉得这个话题很有意思 *wǒ juéde zhège huàtí hěn yǒu yìsi* — I think this is an interesting topic.

The new character, in pieces: 题 — fifteen strokes in two pieces: on the left 是 *shì*, nine strokes, its last stroke sweeping out long under the right side; on the right the page piece, six strokes: a bar, a short left-falling stroke, a narrow box, then a left-falling stroke and a dot under it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

话题 (*huàtí*) is built from 话 'talk' and 题 'a heading', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwaejH* and *dej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'speech' and the second 'the title of a book' and, quoting an older dictionary, 'the forehead'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàtí*
- *Say it: huàtí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège huàtí hěn yǒu yìsi* — I think this is an interesting topic.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to share someone's view, then the Mandarin for to put a question, then say *huàtí* again

Before you move on

What does 话题 mean? ("Topic of conversation".) Say it once more.

354.3 题 — shì, then the page piece

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *huàtí* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  是 话 问

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shì*, *huà*, *wèn*

Script — shì, then the page piece

How 题 *is written, stroke by stroke*

题

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 是, nine strokes, narrower than usual: the sun box on top, a long horizontal, then the lower part, whose last stroke sweeps out long to the right, under the right piece.

The right piece, the page piece, six strokes: a horizontal, a short stroke falling to the left, a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, a left-falling stroke inside, then a dot at the foot.

9 + 6 = fifteen, and the first nine your hand already knows.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 题, all fifteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 題? (**Two**.) What is the left piece? (是.) What does its last stroke do? (**It sweeps out long, under the page piece**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 題, pinned stroke paths and medians.

354.4 tímù — title; question on a test

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put a question, then the Mandarin for a topic of conversation.

You'll want to know: tímù

tímù — "title; question on a test".

wǒ kàn bu dǒng zhège tímù — I can't make sense of this question.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tímù is built from 題 'a heading' and *mù* 'the eye', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dej* and *mjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the title of a book' and, quoting an older dictionary, the second 'the human eye'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tímù*
- *Say it: tímù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ kàn bu dǒng zhège tímù* — I can't make sense of this question.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put a question, then the Mandarin for a topic of conversation, then say *tímù* again

Before you move on

What does tímù mean? ("Title; question on a test".) Say it once more.

354.5 nèiróng — content; what something is about

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a topic of conversation, then the Mandarin for a question on a test.

You'll want to know: nèiróng

nèiróng — "content; what something is about".

zhè běn shū de nèiróng hěn yǒu yìsi — This book has interesting content.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nèiróng is built from *nèi* and *róng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nwojH* and *yowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to enter' and the second 'to hold'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: nèiróng*
- *Say it: nèiróng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè běn shū de nèiróng hěn yǒu yìsi* — This book has interesting content.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a topic of conversation, then the Mandarin for a question on a test, then say *nèiróng* again

Before you move on

What does nèiróng mean? (“Content; what something is about”.) Say it once more.

354.6 tánhuà — to have a serious talk

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a question on a test, then the Mandarin for what something is about.

You’ll want to know: tánhuà

tánhuà — “to have a serious talk”.

lǎoshī xiǎng gēn nǐ tánhuà — The teacher wants a word with you.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tánhuà is built from *tán* and 话 ’talk’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dam* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’to talk’ and the second ’speech’.

What you’ve built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tánhuà*
- *Say it: tánhuà*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī xiǎng gēn nǐ tánhuà* — The teacher wants a word with you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a question on a test, then the Mandarin for what something is about, then say *tánhuà* again

Before you move on

What does tánhuà mean? (“To have a serious talk”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 355

Thanks, but No

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can turn something down politely, say someone won't do something, and say it to their face.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 355: I can turn something down politely, say someone won't do something, and say it to their face.*

355.1 xièjué — to decline politely

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what something is about, then the Mandarin for to have a serious talk.

You'll want to know: xièjué

xièjué — "to decline politely".

> *wǒ qǐng tā chī fàn tā xièjué le* — I invited him to dinner, but he politely declined.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xièjué is built from 谢 and *jué*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zjaeH* and *dzjwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to take leave' and the second 'to cut off'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xièjué*
- *Say it: xièjué*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ qǐng tā chī fàn tā xièjué le* — I invited him to dinner, but he politely declined.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what something is about, then the Mandarin for to have a serious talk, then say *xièjué* again

Before you move on

What does xièjué mean? ("To decline politely".) Say it once more.

355.2 好意 (hǎoyì) — good intentions; a kind thought

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a serious talk, then the Mandarin for to decline politely.

You'll want to know: 好意

好意 — *hǎoyì* — "good intentions; a kind thought".

xièxie nǐ de hǎoyì wǒ zìjǐ néng huí jiā — Thanks for the kind thought, but I can get home on my own.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

好意 (*hǎoyì*) is built from 好 'good' and 意 'intent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'good' and the second 'will'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎoyì*
- *Say it: hǎoyì*, once more
- *Say it: xièxie nǐ de hǎoyì wǒ zìjǐ néng huí jiā* — Thanks for the kind thought, but I can get home on my own.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a serious talk, then the Mandarin for to decline politely, then say *hǎoyì* again

Before you move on

What does 好意 mean? ("Good intentions; a kind thought".) Say it once more.

355.3 kěn — to be willing to; to agree to

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to decline politely, then the Mandarin for a kind thought.

You'll want to know: kěn

kěn — "to be willing to; to agree to".

tā bù kěn gàosu wǒ wèishénme — He won't tell me why.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kěn is inherited from Middle Chinese *khongX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to permit' and, quoting an older dictionary, 'the flesh between the bones'. How it came to mean being willing is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěn*
- *Say it: kěn*, once more
- *Say it: tā bù kěn gàosu wǒ wèishénme* — He won't tell me why.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to decline politely, then the Mandarin for a kind thought, then say *kěn* again

Before you move on

What does kěn mean? ("To be willing to; to agree to".) Say it once more.

355.4 fǒurèn — to deny

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a kind thought, then the Mandarin for to be willing.

You'll want to know: fǒurèn

fǒurèn — "to deny".

wǒ juéde tā bù yīnggāi fǒurèn — I don't think he should deny it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fǒurèn is built from *fǒu* and *rèn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwX* and *nyinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'not', and the second 'to recognize'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fǒurèn*
- *Say it: fǒurèn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde tā bù yīnggāi fǒurèn* — I don't think he should deny it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a kind thought, then the Mandarin for to be willing, then say *fǒurèn* again

Before you move on

What does fǒurèn mean? ("To deny".) Say it once more.

355.5 当面 (dāngmiàn) — to someone's face; in person

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be willing, then the Mandarin for to deny.

You'll want to know: 当面

当面 — *dāngmiàn* — "to someone's face; in person".

nǐ zuìhǎo dāngmiàn gēn tā shuō — You'd better say it to his face.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当面 (*dāngmiàn*) is built from 当 and 面 'the face', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *mjienH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to match' and 'to preside', and the second 'to face' and 'in front'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngmiàn*
- *Say it: dāngmiàn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuìhǎo dāngmiàn gēn tā shuō* — You'd better say it to his face.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be willing, then the Mandarin for to deny, then say *dāngmiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 当面 mean? ("To someone's face; in person".) Say it once more.

Chapter 356

A Missed Chance

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I missed a chance, slipped up and put a mistake right.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 356: I can say I missed a chance, slipped up and put a mistake right.*

356.1 jiàoxun — hard lesson learned

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to deny, then the Mandarin for to someone's face.

You'll want to know: jiàoxun

jiàoxun — "hard lesson learned".

> *wǒ juéde zhè shì yí ge hěn hǎo de jiàoxun* — I think that's a good lesson to learn.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàoxun is built from *jiào* and *xùn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewH* and *xjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to teach' and the second 'to admonish'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàoxun*
- *Say it: jiàoxun*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhè shì yí ge hěn hǎo de jiàoxun* — I think that's a good lesson to learn.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to deny, then the Mandarin for to someone's face, then say *jiàoxun* again

Before you move on

What does jiàoxun mean? ("Hard lesson learned".) Say it once more.

356.2 错过 (cuòguò) — to miss a chance; to miss a train

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to someone's face, then the Mandarin for a hard lesson learned.

You'll want to know: 错过

错过 — *cuòguò* — "to miss a chance; to miss a train".

> 我错过了那个机会 *wǒ cuòguò le nàge jīhuì* — I missed that chance.

The new character, in pieces: 错 — thirteen strokes in two pieces: on the left the metal piece of 钅, five strokes; on the right a short bar with two verticals through it and a long bar under them, then 日 *rì*, eight strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

错过 (*cuòguò*) is built from 错 'wrong' and 过 'to pass', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshak* and *kwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'a file' and 'mixed', and the second 'a mistake' and 'to pass over'. How the first came to mean wrong is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuòguò*
- *Say it: cuòguò*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ cuòguò le nàge jīhuì* — I missed that chance.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to someone's face, then the Mandarin for a hard lesson learned, then say *cuòguò* again

Before you move on

What does 错过 mean? ("To miss a chance; to miss a train".) Say it once more.

356.3 错 — the metal piece, then a cross-bar over the sun

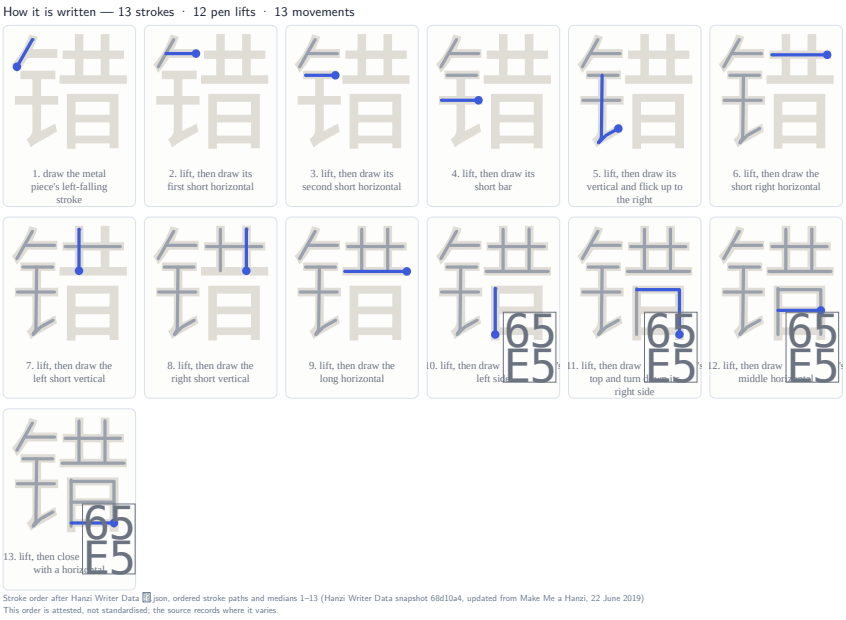
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *cuòguò* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  钱 日 过

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qián*, *rì*, *guò*

Script — the metal piece, then a cross-bar over the sun



How 错 *is written, stroke by stroke*

错

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the metal piece, five strokes, as in 钱: a long left-falling stroke, a short horizontal, a second horizontal, a third that rises to the right, then a vertical that ends rising to the right.

The right piece, eight strokes: a short horizontal, two short verticals down through it, a long horizontal under them, then 日 *rì*, four strokes, at the foot.

5 + 8 = thirteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 错, all thirteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 错? (**Two**.) Which character you know has the same left piece? (钱.) What sits at the foot of the right piece? (日.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 错, pinned stroke paths and medians.

356.4 出错 (chūcuò) — to slip up; to go wrong

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hard lesson learned, then the Mandarin for to miss a chance.

You'll want to know: 出错

出错 — *chūcuò* — "to slip up; to go wrong".

他工作从来不出错 *tā gōngzuò cónglái bù chūcuò* — He never slips up at work.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出错 (*chūcuò*) is built from 出 'to come out' and 错 'wrong', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *tshak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go forward' and 'to appear', and the second 'mixed'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūcuò*
- *Say it: chūcuò*, once more
- *Say it: tā gōngzuò cónglái bù chūcuò* — He never slips up at work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hard lesson learned, then the Mandarin for to miss a chance, then say *chūcuò* again

Before you move on

What does 出错 mean? ("To slip up; to go wrong".) Say it once more.

356.5 cuòwù — mistake; error

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to miss a chance, then the Mandarin for to slip up.

You'll want to know: cuòwù

cuòwù — "mistake; error".

wǒ juéde zhège cuòwù bú dà — I don't think it's a big mistake.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cuòwù is built from 错 'wrong' and *wù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshak* and *nguH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'an error'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuòwù*
- *Say it: cuòwù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège cuòwù bú dà* — I don't think it's a big mistake.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to miss a chance, then the Mandarin for to slip up, then say *cuòwù* again

Before you move on

What does cuòwù mean? ("Mistake; error".) Say it once more.

356.6 gǎizhèng — to put a mistake right

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to slip up, then the Mandarin for an error.

You'll want to know: gǎizhèng

gǎizhèng — "to put a mistake right".

> *nǐ yīnggāi gǎizhèng zhège cuòwù* — You should put this mistake right.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎizhèng is built from *gǎi* and 正 'proper', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *tsyengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to change' and the second 'proper' and 'right'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎizhèng*
- *Say it: gǎizhèng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yīnggāi gǎizhèng zhège cuòwù* — You should put this mistake right.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to slip up, then the Mandarin for an error, then say *gǎizhèng* again

Before you move on

What does gǎizhèng mean? ("To put a mistake right".) Say it once more.

Chapter 357

Owning Up

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone admits they were wrong, and talk about tone, angry words, blame and praise.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 357: I can say someone admits they were wrong, and talk about tone, angry words, blame and praise.*

357.1 rèncuò — to admit you were wrong

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an error, then the Mandarin for to put a mistake right.

You'll want to know: rèncuò

rèncuò — "to admit you were wrong".

> *tā bù kěn rèncuò* — He won't admit he was wrong.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rèncuò is built from *rèn* and 错 'wrong', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyinH* and *tshak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to recognize'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: rèncuò*
- *Say it: rèncuò*, once more
- *Say it: tā bù kěn rèncuò* — He won't admit he was wrong.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an error, then the Mandarin for to put a mistake right, then say *rèncuò* again

Before you move on

What does rèncuò mean? ("To admit you were wrong".) Say it once more.

357.2 气话 (qìhuà) — something said in anger

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put a mistake right, then the Mandarin for to admit you were wrong.

You'll want to know: 气话

气话 — *qìhuà* — "something said in anger".

他说的是气话 *tā shuō de shì qìhuà* — He only said it because he was angry.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

气话 (*qìhuà*) is built from 气 'breath' and 话 'talk', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khj+jH* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'breath' and the second 'speech'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: qìhuà*
- *Say it: qìhuà*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuō de shì qìhuà* — He only said it because he was angry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put a mistake right, then the Mandarin for to admit you were wrong, then say *qìhuà* again

Before you move on

What does 气话 mean? ("Something said in anger".) Say it once more.

357.3 口气 (kǒuqì) — tone of voice; way of saying something

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to admit you were wrong, then the Mandarin for something said in anger.

You'll want to know: 口气

口气 — *kǒuqì* — "tone of voice; way of saying something".

我觉得你说话的口气不太好 *wǒ juéde nǐ shuōhuà de kǒuqì bú tài hǎo* — I don't think your tone is very nice.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

口气 (*kǒuqì*) is built from 口 'the mouth' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuwX* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'what people speak and eat with', and the second 'breath'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǒuqì*
- *Say it: kǒuqì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde nǐ shuōhuà de kǒuqì bú tài hǎo* — I don't think your tone is very nice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to admit you were wrong, then the Mandarin for something said in anger, then say *kǒuqì* again

Before you move on

What does 口气 mean? ("Tone of voice; way of saying something".) Say it once more.

357.4 pīpíng — to criticize

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for something said in anger, then the Mandarin for a tone of voice.

You'll want to know: pīpíng

pīpíng — "to criticize".

yīnwèi tā chídào le suǒyǐ lǎoshī pīpíng le tā — He was late, so the teacher told him off.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pīpíng is built from *pī* and *píng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phej* and *bjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike' and 'to push', and the second 'to weigh up'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: pīpíng*
- *Say it: pīpíng*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi tā chídào le suǒyǐ lǎoshī pīpíng le tā* — He was late, so the teacher told him off.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for something said in anger, then the Mandarin for a tone of voice, then say *pīpíng* again

Before you move on

What does pīpíng mean? ("To criticize".) Say it once more.

357.5 biǎoyáng — to praise (in front of others)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tone of voice, then the Mandarin for to criticize.

You'll want to know: biǎoyáng

biǎoyáng — "to praise (in front of others)".

wǒ juéde nǐ yīnggāi biǎoyáng tā — I think you should praise him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biǎoyáng is built from *biǎo* and *yáng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjewX* and *yang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to make clear' and the second 'to raise' and 'to speak of'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: biǎoyáng*
- *Say it: biǎoyáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde nǐ yīnggāi biǎoyáng tā* — I think you should praise him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tone of voice, then the Mandarin for to criticize, then say *biǎoyáng* again

Before you move on

What does biǎoyáng mean? ("To praise (in front of others)".) Say it once more.

357.6 Looking back: from Same Here to Owning Up

Say the Mandarin for the same feeling and for sure.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the same feeling, for sure, to give your approval, what one really meant, to make your view known
- *Say it:* to talk someone round, the sense something makes, not necessarily, to argue back, to share someone's view
- *Say it:* to put a question, a topic of conversation, a question on a test, what something is about, to have a serious talk
- *Say it:* to decline politely, a kind thought, to be willing, to deny, to someone's face
- *Say it:* a hard lesson learned, to miss a chance, to slip up, an error, to put a mistake right
- *Say it:* to admit you were wrong, something said in anger, a tone of voice, to criticize, to praise
- *Read it:* 道 题 错 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The same feeling? (同感, *tónggǎn.*) For sure? (*kěndìng.*) To give your approval? (*rènkě.*) What one really meant? (本意, *běnyì.*) To make your view known? (*biǎoshì.*) To talk someone round? (*shuōfú.*) The sense something makes? (道理, *dàoli.*) Not necessarily? (不见得, *bújiànde.*) To argue back? (*fǎnbó.*) To share someone's view? (*rèntóng.*) To put a question? (*tíwèn.*) A topic of conversation? (话题, *huàtí.*) A question on a test? (*tímù.*) What something is about? (*nèiróng.*) To have a serious talk? (*tánhuà.*) To decline politely? (*xièjué.*) A kind thought? (好意, *hǎoyì.*) To be willing? (*kěn.*) To deny? (*fǒurèn.*) To someone's face? (当面, *dāngmiàn.*) A hard lesson learned? (*jiàoxun.*) To miss a chance? (错过, *cuòguò.*) To slip up? (出错, *chūcuò.*) An error? (*cuòwù.*) To put a mistake right? (*gǎizhèng.*) To admit you were wrong? (*rèncuò.*) Something said in anger? (气话, *qìhuà.*) A tone of voice? (口气, *kǒuqì.*) To criticize? (*pīpíng.*) To praise? (*biǎoyáng.*)

Chapter 358

Real Manners

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about good manners, being sincere and modest, and saving face.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 358: I can talk about good manners, being sincere and modest, and saving face.*

358.1 lǐmào — good manners; politeness

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to criticize, then the Mandarin for to praise.

You'll want to know: lǐmào

lǐmào — "good manners; politeness".

> *zhège háizi hěn yǒu lǐmào* — This child has very good manners.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǐmào is built from *lǐ* and *mào*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lejX* and *maewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'that by which the spirits are served and blessing is brought', and gives the second only as an older spelling. How the pair came to mean manners is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐmào*
- *Say it: lǐmào*, once more
- *Say it: zhège háizi hěn yǒu lǐmào* — This child has very good manners.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to criticize, then the Mandarin for to praise, then say *lǐmào* again

Before you move on

What does lǐmào mean? ("Good manners; politeness".) Say it once more.

358.2 真正 (zhēnzhèng) — real; genuine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to praise, then the Mandarin for good manners.

You'll want to know: 真正

真正 — *zhēnzhèng* — "real; genuine".

我觉得这是真正的中国菜 *wǒ juéde zhè shì zhēnzhèng de Zhōngguó cài* — I think this is real Chinese food.

The new character, in pieces: 真 — ten strokes: 十 *shí* on top, a narrow box with two bars inside it under that, a long bar across, and two short dots under it, left then right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

真正 (*zhēnzhèng*) is built from 真 'true' and 正 'proper', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyin* and *tsyengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'true, as against false' and the

second 'proper'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhēnzhèng*
- *Say it: zhēnzhèng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhè shì zhēnzhèng de Zhōngguó cài* — I think this is real Chinese food.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to praise, then the Mandarin for good manners, then say *zhēnzhèng* again

Before you move on

What does 真正 mean? ("Real; genuine".) Say it once more.

358.3 真 — ten, a box, a bar and two dots

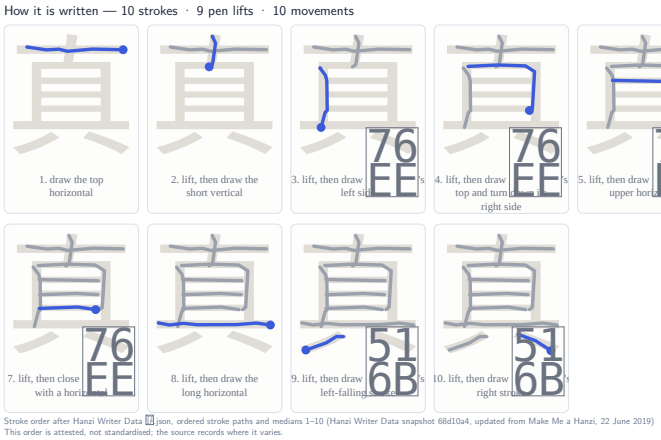
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhēnzhèng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  十 正

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shí*, *zhèng*

Script — ten, a box, a bar and two dots



How 真 *is written, stroke by stroke*

真

One piece, top to bottom. Count it in four parts, not ten strokes.

十 **on top, two strokes**: a horizontal, then a vertical down through it.

A narrow box, five strokes: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, two short horizontals inside, then one closing the foot of the box.

A long horizontal across the whole width under the box.

Two short strokes at the foot: one falling to the left, then one falling to the right.

2 + 5 + 1 + 2 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 真, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

What sits on top of 真? (十.) How many bars inside the box? (**Two**, and one closing it.) What comes last? (**Two short strokes, left then right**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 真, pinned stroke paths and medians.

358.4 真心 (zhēnxīn) — sincere; from the bottom of your heart

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for good manners, then the Mandarin for genuine.

You'll want to know: 真心

真心 — *zhēnxīn* — "sincere; from the bottom of your heart".

我真心觉得你说得有道理 *wǒ zhēnxīn juéde nǐ shuō de yǒu dàoli* — I honestly think you've got a point.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

真心 (*zhēnxīn*) is built from 真 'true' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyin* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'true, as against false'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhēnxīn*
- *Say it: zhēnxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhēnxīn juéde nǐ shuō de yǒu dàoli* — I honestly think you've got a point.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for good manners, then the Mandarin for genuine, then say *zhēnxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 真心 mean? (“Sincere; from the bottom of your heart”.) Say it once more.

358.5 qiānxū — modest

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for genuine, then the Mandarin for from the bottom of your heart.

You’ll want to know: qiānxū

qiānxū — “modest”.

nǐ tài qiānxū le — You’re being too modest.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiānxū is built from *qiān* and *xū*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khem* and *xjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’respectful’ and ’to yield’, and the second ’empty’.

What you’ve built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiānxū*
- *Say it: qiānxū*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ tài qiānxū le* — You’re being too modest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for genuine, then the Mandarin for from the bottom of your heart, then say *qiānxū* again

Before you move on

What does qiānxū mean? (“Modest”.) Say it once more.

358.6 面子 (miànzi) — face; your standing in others' eyes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for from the bottom of your heart, then the Mandarin for modest about yourself.

You'll want to know: 面子

面子 — *miànzi* — "face; your standing in others' eyes".

他很要面子 *tā hěn yào miànzi* — He cares a lot about saving face.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

面子 (*miànzi*) is built from 面 'the face' and 子, a noun ending, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjienH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to face' and the second 'a child'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: miànzi*
- *Say it: miànzi*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn yào miànzi* — He cares a lot about saving face.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for from the bottom of your heart, then the Mandarin for modest about yourself, then say *miànzi* again

Before you move on

What does 面子 mean? ("Face; your standing in others' eyes".) Say it once more.

Chapter 359

Rules

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about keeping and breaking rules, putting limits on things, and what is right.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 359: I can talk about keeping and breaking rules, putting limits on things, and what is right.*

359.1 guīzé — rules of a game; set procedure

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for modest about yourself, then the Mandarin for face (your standing).

You'll want to know: guīzé

guīzé — "rules of a game; set procedure".

> *zhège bǐsài de guīzé hěn jiǎndān* — The rules of this game are simple.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guīzé is built from *guī* and *zé*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjwie* and *tsok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'round' and the second 'a rule'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: guīzé*
- *Say it: guīzé*, once more
- *Say it: zhège bǐsài de guīzé hěn jiǎndān* — The rules of this game are simple.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for modest about yourself, then the Mandarin for face (your standing), then say *guīzé* again

Before you move on

What does guīzé mean? ("Rules of a game; set procedure".) Say it once more.

359.2 zūnshǒu — to keep to; to abide by

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for face (your standing), then the Mandarin for the rules of a game.

You'll want to know: zūnshǒu

zūnshǒu — "to keep to; to abide by".

wǒmen yīnggāi zūnshǒu guīzé — We should keep to the rules.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zūnshǒu is built from *zūn* and *shǒu*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tswin* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to follow' and the second 'to guard'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zūnshǒu*
- *Say it: zūnshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi zūnshǒu guīzé* — We should keep to the rules.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for face (your standing), then the Mandarin for the rules of a game, then say *zūnshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does zūnshǒu mean? ("To keep to; to abide by".) Say it once more.

359.3 wéifǎn — to break a rule; to go against the law

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the rules of a game, then the Mandarin for to abide by.

You'll want to know: wéifǎn

wéifǎn — "to break a rule; to go against the law".

tā wéifǎn le xuéxiào de guīdìng — He broke the school rules.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wéifǎn is built from *wéi* and *fǎn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjw+j* and *pjonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn one's back on' and the second 'to turn over'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wéifǎn*
- *Say it: wéifǎn*, once more
- *Say it: tā wéifǎn le xuéxiào de guīdìng* — He broke the school rules.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the rules of a game, then the Mandarin for to abide by, then say *wéifǎn* again

Before you move on

What does wéifǎn mean? ("To break a rule; to go against the law".) Say it once more.

359.4 xiànzhì — to put a limit on; to restrict

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to abide by, then the Mandarin for to break a rule.

You'll want to know: xiànzhì

xiànzhì — "to put a limit on; to restrict".

wǒmen yīnggāi xiànzhì háizi shàngwǎng de shíjiān — We should limit how long children spend online.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiànzhì is built from *xiàn* and *zhì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *heanX* and *tsyejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a measure' and 'a boundary', and the second 'to restrain'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiànzhì*
- *Say it: xiànzhì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi xiànzhì háizi shàngwǎng de shíjiān* — We should limit how long children spend online.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to abide by, then the Mandarin for to break a rule, then say *xiànzhì* again

Before you move on

What does xiànzhì mean? ("To put a limit on; to restrict".) Say it once more.

359.5 dàodé — morality; ethics

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to break a rule, then the Mandarin for to put a limit on.

You'll want to know: dàodé

dàodé — "morality; ethics".

wǒ juéde zhè shì dàodé wèntí — I think it's a moral question.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàodé is built from 道 'a way' and *dé* 'virtue', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dawX* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a principle' and the second 'virtuous conduct'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàodé*
- *Say it: dàodé*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhè shì dàodé wèntí* — I think it's a moral question.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to break a rule, then the Mandarin for to put a limit on, then say *dàodé* again

Before you move on

What does dàodé mean? ("Morality; ethics".) Say it once more.

Chapter 360

No Need

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what is necessary, what there is no need for, and what suits the occasion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 360: I can say what is necessary, what there is no need for, and what suits the occasion.*

360.1 gōnggòng — public; shared by everyone

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put a limit on, then the Mandarin for morality.

You'll want to know: gōnggòng

gōnggòng — "public; shared by everyone".

> *zhèr yǒu gōnggòng cèsuǒ ma* — Is there a public toilet here?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōnggòng is built from 公 and *gòng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *gjowngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'shared' and 'upright', and the second 'together' and 'all'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōnggòng*
- *Say it: gōnggòng*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr yǒu gōnggòng cèsuǒ ma* — Is there a public toilet here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put a limit on, then the Mandarin for morality, then say *gōnggòng* again

Before you move on

What does gōnggòng mean? ("Public; shared by everyone".) Say it once more.

360.2 必要 (bìyào) — necessary

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for morality, then the Mandarin for shared by everyone.

You'll want to know: 必要

必要 — *bìyào* — "necessary".

我觉得没有必要问这个问题 *wǒ juéde méiyǒu bìyào wèn zhège wèntí* — I don't think there's any need to ask that.

The new character, in pieces: 必 — five strokes: a dot on the left, the long curve along the foot that hooks up, as in 心, a dot on top, a long left-falling stroke down through the curve, and a dot on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

必要 (*bìyào*) is built from *bì* and 要 'to need', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjit* and *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'certain' and 'so', and the second 'to bind'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìyào*
- *Say it: bìyào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde méiyǒu bìyào wèn zhège wèntí* — I don't think there's any need to ask that.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for morality, then the Mandarin for shared by everyone, then say *bìyào* again

Before you move on

What does 必要 mean? ("Necessary".) Say it once more.

360.3 必 — the strokes of the heart, with a sweep through them

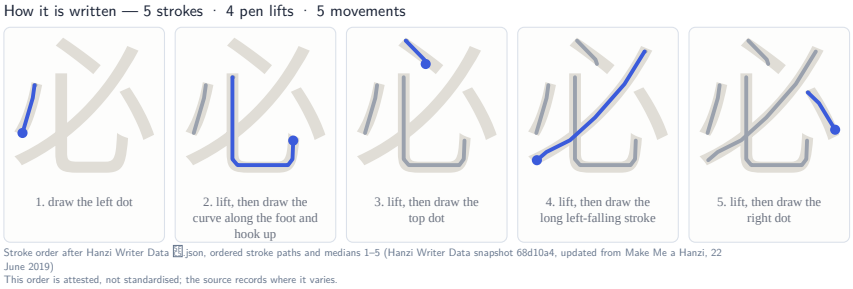
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bìyào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  心 要

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xīn*, *yào*

Script — the strokes of the heart, with a sweep through them



How 必 is written, stroke by stroke

必

One piece, five strokes. It looks like 心 crossed by a long sweep; the order is its own.

A dot on the left, falling down to the left.

The long curve along the foot, sweeping right and hooking up, as in 心.

A dot on top, falling to the right.

A long left-falling stroke from the top right down through the curve to the bottom left. Only then:

the dot on the right, last.

Five strokes, and the sweep comes before the last dot.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 必, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 必? (**Five**.) Which character you know has the same curve? (心.) What comes right before the last dot? (**The long left-falling stroke**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 必, pinned stroke paths and medians.

360.4 不必 (búbì) — need not; there's no need to

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for shared by everyone, then the Mandarin for necessary.

You'll want to know: 不必

不必 — *búbì* — "need not; there's no need to".

> 你不必说对不起你没有错 *nǐ búbì shuō duìbuqǐ nǐ méiyǒu cuò* — You needn't apologize; you did nothing wrong.

The tone of bù changes here: before a falling tone it is said bú, and the spelling writes the change.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不必 (*búbì*) is built from 不 'not' and 必 'surely', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *pjit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'certain' and 'so'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: búbì*
- *Say it: búbì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ búbì shuō duìbuqǐ nǐ méiyǒu cuò* — You needn't apologize; you did nothing wrong.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for shared by everyone, then the Mandarin for necessary, then say *búbì* again

Before you move on

What does 不必 mean? ("Need not; there's no need to".) Say it once more.

360.5 chǎnghé — occasion; setting

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for necessary, then the Mandarin for there's no need to.

You'll want to know: chǎnghé

chǎnghé — "occasion; setting".

nǐ yīnggāi kàn chǎnghé shuōhuà — You should suit what you say to the occasion.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǎnghé is built from *chǎng* and *hé*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjang* and *hop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a place of offering' and 'a threshing floor', and the second 'to join'. Middle Chinese *drjang* would regularly give cháng; the dipping tone of chǎng is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǎnghé*
- *Say it: chǎnghé*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yīnggāi kàn chǎnghé shuōhuà* — You should suit what you say to the occasion.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for necessary, then the Mandarin for there's no need to, then say *chǎnghé* again

Before you move on

What does chǎnghé mean? ("Occasion; setting".) Say it once more.

360.6 chāduì — to jump the queue

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for there's no need to, then the Mandarin for the occasion you are in.

You'll want to know: chāduì

chāduì — "to jump the queue".

> *dàjiā dōu zài páiduì nǐ bù yīnggāi chāduì* — Everyone's queuing; you shouldn't push in.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chāduì is built from *chā* and *duì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrheap* and *dwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to thrust in' and the second 'a troop'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāduì*
- *Say it: chāduì*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu zài páiduì nǐ bù yīnggāi chāduì* — Everyone's queuing; you shouldn't push in.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for there's no need to, then the Mandarin for the occasion you are in, then say *chāduì* again

Before you move on

What does chāduì mean? ("To jump the queue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 361

A Good Guest, a Good Host

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say hello properly, bow, look after guests and propose a toast.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 361: I can say hello properly, bow, look after guests and propose a toast.*

361.1 dǎ zhāohu — to say hello to someone

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the occasion you are in, then the Mandarin for to jump the queue.

You'll want to know: dǎ zhāohu

dǎ zhāohu — "to say hello to someone".

> *wǒmen jiànmiàn de shíhou yīnggāi dǎ zhāohu* — We should say hello when we meet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎ zhāohu is built from 扌丁 'to strike' and *zhāohu*, all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX*, *tsyew* and *xu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike', the second 'to beckon' and the third 'to call out'. The last syllable is said light.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎ zhāohu*
- *Say it: dǎ zhāohu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiànmiàn de shíhou yīnggāi dǎ zhāohu* — We should say hello when we meet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the occasion you are in, then the Mandarin for to jump the queue, then say *dǎ zhāohu* again

Before you move on

What does dǎ zhāohu mean? ("To say hello to someone".) Say it once more.

361.2 zhāodài — to look after your guests; to entertain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to jump the queue, then the Mandarin for to say hello to someone.

You'll want to know: zhāodài

zhāodài — "to look after your guests; to entertain".

tāmen zhāodài kèrén hěn rèqíng — They're very warm hosts.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhāodài is built from *zhāo* and *dài*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyew* and *dojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to beckon' and the second 'to wait'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhāodài*
- *Say it: zhāodài*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen zhāodài kèrén hěn rèqíng* — They're very warm hosts.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to jump the queue, then the Mandarin for to say hello to someone, then say *zhāodài* again

Before you move on

What does zhāodài mean? ("To look after your guests; to entertain".) Say it once more.

361.3 jūgōng — to bow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to say hello to someone, then the Mandarin for to look after your guests.

You'll want to know: jūgōng

jūgōng — "to bow".

yǎnchū yǐhòu yǎnyuán yìqǐ jūgōng — After the show, the actors bow together.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jūgōng is built from *jū* and *gōng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjuwk* and *kjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to examine closely' and 'to rear', and the second 'the body'. How the pair came to mean bowing is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jūgōng*
- *Say it: jūgōng*, once more
- *Say it: yǎnchū yǐhòu yǎnyuán yìqǐ jūgōng* — After the show, the actors bow together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to say hello to someone, then the Mandarin for to look after your guests, then say *jūgōng* again

Before you move on

What does jūgōng mean? ("To bow".) Say it once more.

361.4 jìngjiǔ — to propose a toast

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look after your guests, then the Mandarin for to bow.

You'll want to know: jìngjiǔ

jìngjiǔ — "to propose a toast".

zài Zhōngguó chī fàn de shíhou dàjiā chángcháng jìngjiǔ — In China people often propose toasts at meals.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìngjiǔ is built from *jìng* and *jiǔ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengH* and *tsjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'respectful' and the second 'wine'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìngjiǔ*
- *Say it: jìngjiǔ*, once more
- *Say it: zài Zhōngguó chī fàn de shíhou dàjiā chángcháng jìngjiǔ* — In China people often propose toasts at meals.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look after your guests, then the Mandarin for to bow, then say *jìngjiǔ* again

Before you move on

What does jìngjiǔ mean? ("To propose a toast".) Say it once more.

361.5 看不起 (kànbuqǐ) — to look down on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to bow, then the Mandarin for to propose a toast.

You'll want to know: 看不起

看不起 — *kànbuqǐ* — "to look down on".

你不应该看不起他 *nǐ bù yīnggāi kànbuqǐ tā* — You shouldn't look down on him.

The tone of bù is lost here: between the two parts it is said light, bu.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

看不起 (*kànbuqǐ*) is built from 看, 不 'not' and 起 'to rise', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *khan*, *pjut* and *khiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to view' and the third 'to rise'. How the three came to mean looking down on someone is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kànbuqǐ*
- *Say it: kànbuqǐ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bù yīnggāi kànbuqǐ tā* — You shouldn't look down on him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to bow, then the Mandarin for to propose a toast, then say *kànbuqǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 看不起 mean? ("To look down on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 362

What You Have to Do

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what you have to do, ask someone not to be loud, and say what is fair.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 362: I can say what you have to do, ask someone not to be loud, and say what is fair.*

362.1 dàshēng — loudly; in a loud voice

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to propose a toast, then the Mandarin for to look down on someone.

You'll want to know: dàshēng

dàshēng — "loudly; in a loud voice".

> *qǐng búyào dàshēng shuōhuà* — Please don't talk loudly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàshēng is built from 大 'big' and *shēng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dajH* and *syeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'big' and the second 'a sound'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàshēng*
- *Say it: dàshēng*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng búyào dàshēng shuōhuà* — Please don't talk loudly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to propose a toast, then the Mandarin for to look down on someone, then say *dàshēng* again

Before you move on

What does dàshēng mean? ("Loudly; in a loud voice".) Say it once more.

362.2 必须 (bìxū) — must; it is required that

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look down on someone, then the Mandarin for in a loud voice.

You'll want to know: 必须

必须 — *bìxū* — "must; it is required that".

上课的时候必须关手机 *shàngkè de shíhou bìxū guān shǒujī* — You have to switch your phone off in class.

The new character, in pieces: 须 — nine strokes in two pieces: on the left three left-falling strokes, one under another; on the right the page piece of 题, six strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

必须 (*bìxū*) is built from 必 'surely' and *xū*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjit* and *sju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'certain' and the second 'what the mind wants' and, quoting an older dictionary, 'the hair of the face'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìxū*
- *Say it: bìxū*, once more
- *Say it: shàngkè de shíhou bìxū guān shǒujī* — You have to switch your phone off in class.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look down on someone, then the Mandarin for in a loud voice, then say *bìxū* again

Before you move on

What does 必须 mean? ("Must; it is required that".) Say it once more.

362.3 须 — three sweeps, then the page piece

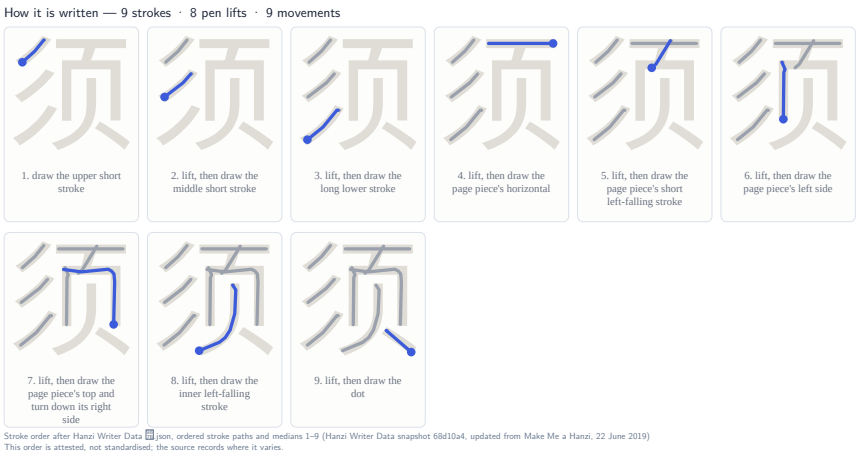
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bìxū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  题 必

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *tí*, *bì*

Script — three sweeps, then the page piece



How 须 *is written, stroke by stroke*

须

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes: three short strokes falling to the left, one under another, the last the longest.

The right piece, the page piece, six strokes, as on the right of 题: a horizontal, a short left-falling stroke, a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, a left-falling stroke inside, then a dot at the foot.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 须, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 须? (**Two.**) Where have you written the right piece? (**On the right of** 题.) How many strokes on the left? (**Three, all falling to the left.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 须, pinned stroke paths and medians.

362.4 luàn — messy; in a mess

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in a loud voice, then the Mandarin for must (a firm requirement).

You'll want to know: luàn

luàn — "messy; in a mess".

nǐ de fángjiān tài luàn le — Your room is far too messy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

luàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *lwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it both 'to put in order' and 'disorder'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: luàn*
- *Say it: luàn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de fángjiān tài luàn le* — Your room is far too messy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in a loud voice, then the Mandarin for must (a firm requirement), then say *luàn* again

Before you move on

What does luàn mean? ("Messy; in a mess".) Say it once more.

362.5 公正 (gōngzhèng) — fair; impartial

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for must (a firm requirement), then the Mandarin for in a mess.

You'll want to know: 公正

公正 — *gōngzhèng* — "fair; impartial".

> 我觉得校长很公正 *wǒ juéde xiàozhǎng hěn gōngzhèng* — I think the head is very fair.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

公正 (*gōngzhèng*) is built from 公 and 正 'proper', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *tsyengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'upright' and 'selfless', and the second 'proper'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngzhèng*
- *Say it: gōngzhèng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde xiàozhǎng hěn gōngzhèng* — I think the head is very fair.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for must (a firm requirement), then the Mandarin for in a mess, then say *gōngzhèng* again

Before you move on

What does 公正 mean? ("Fair; impartial".) Say it once more.

362.6 yìwù — duty; obligation

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in a mess, then the Mandarin for impartial.

You'll want to know: yìwù

yìwù — "duty; obligation".

> *wǒ juéde zhè shì dàjiā de yìwù* — I think it's everyone's duty.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìwù is built from *yì* and *wù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjeH* and *mjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'benevolence and right conduct' and the second 'affairs'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìwù*
- *Say it: yìwù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhè shì dàjiā de yìwù* — I think it's everyone's duty.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in a mess, then the Mandarin for impartial, then say *yìwù* again

Before you move on

What does yìwù mean? ("Duty; obligation".) Say it once more.

Chapter 363

Out in Public

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about respect, speaking quietly, the law and how people behave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 363: I can talk about respect, speaking quietly, the law and how people behave.*

363.1 zūnzhòng — to show respect for; to respect

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for impartial, then the Mandarin for a duty you owe.

You'll want to know: zūnzhòng

zūnzhòng — "to show respect for; to respect".

> *wǒmen yīnggāi zūnzhòng biérén de xiǎngfǎ* — We should respect other people's ideas.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zūnzhòng is built from *zūn* and 重 'heavy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tswon* and *drjowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'honoured, as against humble' and the second 'much' and 'careful'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zūnzhòng*
- *Say it: zūnzhòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi zūnzhòng biérén de xiǎngfǎ* — We should respect other people's ideas.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for impartial, then the Mandarin for a duty you owe, then say *zūnzhòng* again

Before you move on

What does zūnzhòng mean? ("To show respect for; to respect".) Say it once more.

363.2 xiǎoshēng — in a low voice; quietly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a duty you owe, then the Mandarin for to show respect for.

You'll want to know: xiǎoshēng

xiǎoshēng — "in a low voice; quietly".

zài yīyuàn lǐ yīnggāi xiǎoshēng shuōhuà — You should speak quietly in a hospital.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiǎoshēng is built from 小 'small' and *shēng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *syeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'tiny' and the second 'a sound'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoshēng*
- *Say it: xiǎoshēng*, once more
- *Say it: zài yīyuàn lǐ yīnggāi xiǎoshēng shuōhuà* — You should speak quietly in a hospital.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a duty you owe, then the Mandarin for to show respect for, then say *xiǎoshēng* again

Before you move on

What does xiǎoshēng mean? ("In a low voice; quietly".) Say it once more.

363.3 fǎlǜ — law; the law

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to show respect for, then the Mandarin for in a low voice.

You'll want to know: fǎlǜ

fǎlǜ — "law; the law".

wǒmen bìxū zūnshǒu fǎlǜ — We must obey the law.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fǎlǜ is built from 法 'a rule' and *lǜ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjop* and *lwit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a rule' and the second 'the pitch pipes' and 'a law'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fǎlǜ*
- *Say it: fǎlǜ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen bìxū zūnshǒu fǎlǜ* — We must obey the law.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to show respect for, then the Mandarin for in a low voice, then say *fǎlǜ* again

Before you move on

What does fǎlǜ mean? ("Law; the law".) Say it once more.

363.4 fànfǎ — to break the law

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in a low voice, then the Mandarin for the law.

You'll want to know: fànfǎ

fànfǎ — "to break the law".

hējiǔ yǐhòu kāichē fànfǎ — Driving after drinking is against the law.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fànfǎ is built from *fàn* and 法 'a rule', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjomX* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to offend against' and 'to intrude', and the second 'a rule'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fànfǎ*
- *Say it: fànfǎ*, once more
- *Say it: hējiǔ yǐhòu kāichē fànfǎ* — Driving after drinking is against the law.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in a low voice, then the Mandarin for the law, then say *fànfǎ* again

Before you move on

What does fànfǎ mean? ("To break the law".) Say it once more.

363.5 sùzhì — a person's quality; upbringing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the law, then the Mandarin for to break the law.

You'll want to know: sùzhì

sùzhì — "a person's quality; upbringing".

wǒ juéde zhège rén sùzhì hěn gāo — I think he's a very well brought-up person.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sùzhì is built from *sù* and *zhì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *suH* and *tsyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'empty' and 'silk', and the second 'plain' and 'sincere'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: sùzhì*
- *Say it: sùzhì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège rén sùzhì hěn gāo* — I think he's a very well brought-up person.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the law, then the Mandarin for to break the law, then say *sùzhì* again

Before you move on

What does sùzhì mean? ("A person's quality; upbringing".) Say it once more.

363.6 Looking back: from Real Manners to Out in Public

Say the Mandarin for good manners and genuine.

Your turn

- *Say it:* good manners, genuine, from the bottom of your heart, modest about yourself, face (your standing)
- *Say it:* the rules of a game, to abide by, to break a rule, to put a limit on, morality
- *Say it:* shared by everyone, necessary, there's no need to, the occasion you are in, to jump the queue
- *Say it:* to say hello to someone, to look after your guests, to bow, to propose a toast, to look down on someone
- *Say it:* in a loud voice, must (a firm requirement), in a mess, impartial, a duty you owe
- *Say it:* to show respect for, in a low voice, the law, to break the law, a person's character and upbringing
- *Read it:* 真 必 须 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Good manners? (*lǐmào.*) Genuine? (真正, *zhēnzhèng.*) From the bottom of your heart? (真心, *zhēnxīn.*) Modest about yourself? (*qiānxū.*) Face (your standing)? (面子, *miànzi.*) The rules of a game? (*guīzé.*) To abide by? (*zūnshǒu.*) To break a rule? (*wéifǎn.*) To put a limit on? (*xiànzhì.*) Morality? (*dàodé.*) Shared by everyone? (*gōnggòng.*) Necessary? (必要, *bìyào.*) There's no need to? (不必, *búbì.*) The occasion you are in? (*chǎnghé.*) To jump the queue? (*chāduì.*) To say hello to someone? (*dǎ zhāohu.*) To look after your guests? (*zhāodài.*) To bow? (*jūgōng.*) To propose a toast? (*jìngjiǔ.*) To look down on someone? (看不起, *kànbuqǐ.*) In a loud voice? (*dàshēng.*) Must (a firm requirement)? (必须, *bìxū.*) In a mess? (*luàn.*) Impartial? (公正, *gōngzhèng.*) A duty you owe? (*yìwù.*) To show respect for? (*zūnzhòng.*) In a low voice? (*xiǎoshēng.*) The law? (*fǎlǜ.*) To break the law? (*fànfǎ.*) A person's character and upbringing? (*sùzhì.*)

Chapter 364

Not Allowed

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what is not allowed, urge and remind someone, and say a plan was approved.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 364: I can say what is not allowed, urge and remind someone, and say a plan was approved.*

364.1 quàn — to urge; to try to persuade

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to break the law, then the Mandarin for a person's character and upbringing.

You'll want to know: quàn

quàn — "to urge; to try to persuade".

> *wǒ quàn tā zuìhǎo bié hējiǔ* — I urged him not to drink.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

quàn is inherited from Middle Chinese *khjwonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it 'to encourage' and 'to teach'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: quàn*
- *Say it: quàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ quàn tā zuìhǎo bié hējiǔ* — I urged him not to drink.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to break the law, then the Mandarin for a person's character and upbringing, then say *quàn* again

Before you move on

What does quàn mean? ("To urge; to try to persuade".) Say it once more.

364.2 不准 (bùzhǔn) — to not allow

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a person's character and upbringing, then the Mandarin for to urge someone.

You'll want to know: 不准

不准 — *bùzhǔn* — "to not allow".

上课的时候不准吃东西 *shàngkè de shíhou bùzhǔn chī dōngxi* — No eating in class.

The new character, in pieces: 准 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left the ice piece of 冷, two strokes; on the right a bird piece, eight strokes: a left-falling stroke, a long vertical, a dot, three short bars, a vertical down through them, and a long bar at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The tone of bù stays falling here, because the next syllable is not a falling tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不准 (*bùzhǔn*) is built from 不 'not' and *zhǔn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *tsywinX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the second as the everyday spelling of a word glossed 'even' and 'level'. How it came to mean allowing is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùzhǔn*
- *Say it: bùzhǔn*, once more
- *Say it: shàngkè de shíhou bùzhǔn chī dōngxi* — No eating in class.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a person's character and upbringing, then the Mandarin for to urge someone, then say *bùzhǔn* again

Before you move on

What does 不准 mean? ("To not allow".) Say it once more.

364.3 准 — the ice piece, then the bird piece

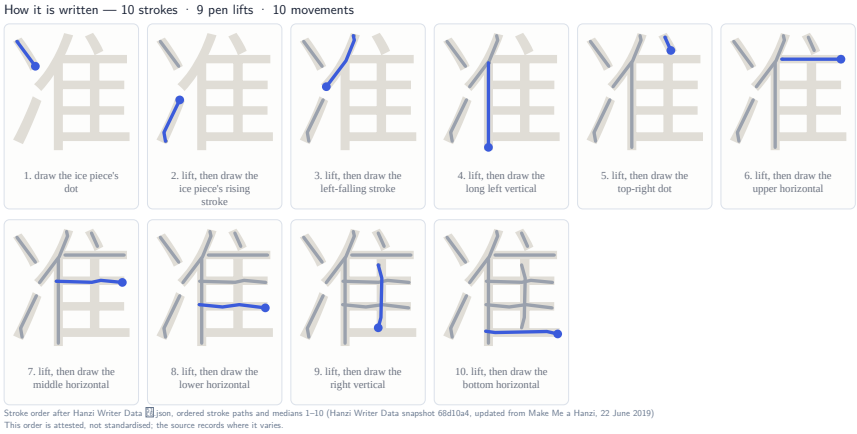
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bùzhǔn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  冷 不

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lěng*, *bù*

Script — the ice piece, then the bird piece



How 准 *is written, stroke by stroke*

准

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the ice piece, two strokes, as in 冷: a dot, then a stroke rising from the bottom left.

The right piece, the bird piece, eight strokes: a left-falling stroke, a long vertical down the left side, a dot at the top right, three short horizontals, a vertical down through them, then a long horizontal at the foot.

2 + 8 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 准, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 准? (**Two**.) Which character you know has the same left piece? (冷.) What closes the bird piece? (**A long horizontal at the foot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 准, pinned stroke paths and medians.

364.4 biāozhǔn — standard to measure by

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to urge someone, then the Mandarin for to not allow.

You'll want to know: biāozhǔn

biāozhǔn — "standard to measure by".

wǒ juéde zhège biāozhǔn tài gāo le — I think the standard is set too high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biāozhǔn is built from *biāo* and 准 'level', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjiew* and *tsywinX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to raise' and 'the tip of a tree', and the second 'level'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: biāozhǔn*
- *Say it: biāozhǔn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège biāozhǔn tài gāo le* — I think the standard is set too high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to urge someone, then the Mandarin for to not allow, then say *biāozhǔn* again

Before you move on

What does biāozhǔn mean? ("Standard to measure by".) Say it once more.

364.5 pīzhǔn — to give official approval; to approve a plan

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to not allow, then the Mandarin for a standard to measure by.

You'll want to know: pīzhǔn

pīzhǔn — "to give official approval; to approve a plan".

xiàozhǎng pīzhǔn le wǒmen de jìhuà — The head approved our plan.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pīzhǔn is built from *pī* and 准 'level', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phej* and *tsywinX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike' and 'to show', and the second 'level'. How the pair came to mean approving is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: pīzhǔn*
- *Say it: pīzhǔn*, once more
- *Say it: xiàozhǎng pīzhǔn le wǒmen de jìhuà* — The head approved our plan.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to not allow, then the Mandarin for a standard to measure by, then say *pīzhǔn* again

Before you move on

What does pīzhǔn mean? ("To give official approval; to approve a plan".) Say it once more.

364.6 tíxǐng — to remind

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a standard to measure by, then the Mandarin for to give official approval.

You'll want to know: tíxǐng

tíxǐng — "to remind".

qǐng tíxǐng wǒ míngtiān dài shū — Please remind me to bring the book tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tíxǐng is built from *tí* and *xǐng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dej* and *sengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to carry by the hand' and the second 'to sober up'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíxǐng*
- *Say it: tíxǐng*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng tíxǐng wǒ míngtiān dài shū* — Please remind me to bring the book tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a standard to measure by, then the Mandarin for to give official approval, then say *tíxǐng* again

Before you move on

What does tíxǐng mean? ("To remind".) Say it once more.

Chapter 365

Yes, but

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say but, suggest what someone should do and say what goes to show.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 365: I can say but, suggest what someone should do and say what goes to show.*

365.1 jiànyì — to suggest

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give official approval, then the Mandarin for to remind someone.

You'll want to know: jiànyì

jiànyì — "to suggest".

> *yīnwèi nǐ bìng le suǒyǐ wǒ jiànyì nǐ qù kàn yīshēng* — You're ill, so I suggest you go and see a doctor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiànyì is built from *jiàn* and *yì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjonH* and *ngjeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to set up' and the second 'to deliberate'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànyì*
- *Say it: jiànyì*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi nǐ bìng le suǒyǐ wǒ jiànyì nǐ qù kàn yīshēng* — You're ill, so I suggest you go and see a doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give official approval, then the Mandarin for to remind someone, then say *jiànyì* again

Before you move on

What does jiànyì mean? ("To suggest".) Say it once more.

365.2 可是 (kěshì) — but; yet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to remind someone, then the Mandarin for to suggest.

You'll want to know: 可是

可是 — *kěshì* — "but; yet".

> 你说得很有道理可是我不想去 *nǐ shuō de hěn yǒu dàoli kěshì wǒ bù xiǎng qù* — You've got a point, but I don't want to go.

The new character, in pieces: 可 — five strokes: a long bar on top, 口 *kǒu* under it on the left, three strokes, and a long vertical down the right that hooks at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

可是 (*kěshì*) is built from *kě* and 是, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and the second 'right, as against wrong'. How the pair came to mean but is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěshì*
- *Say it: kěshì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shuō de hěn yǒu dàoli kěshì wǒ bù xiǎng qù* — You've got a point, but I don't want to go.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to remind someone, then the Mandarin for to suggest, then say *kěshì* again

Before you move on

What does 可是 mean? ("But; yet".) Say it once more.

365.3 可 — a bar, a mouth and a hook

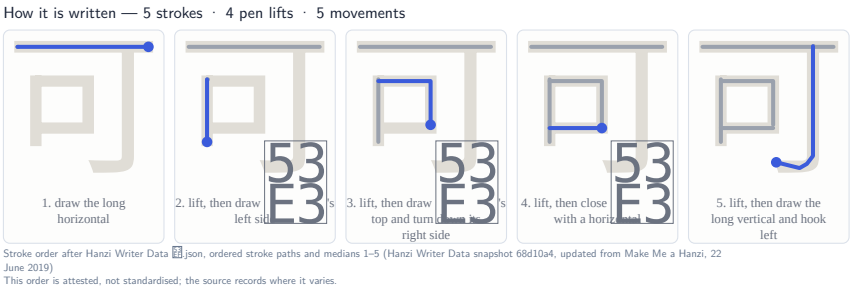
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kěshì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

口 是

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *shì*

Script — a bar, a mouth and a hook



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data .json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–5 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 可 is written, stroke by stroke

可

One piece, five strokes. Count it in three parts.

A long horizontal across the top.

口, three strokes, small, under the bar on the left: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, and the bottom horizontal.

A long vertical down the right side, from the bar to the foot, hooking up to the left.

1 + 3 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 可, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 可? (**Five**.) What is the small box? (口.) What comes last? (**The long vertical with its hook**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 可, pinned stroke paths and medians.

365.4 可见 (kějiàn) — which goes to show; so it is clear that

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to suggest, then the Mandarin for but (in everyday speech).

You'll want to know: 可见

可见 — *kějiàn* — "which goes to show; so it is clear that".

他每天都准时来可见他很喜欢这儿 *tā měitiān dōu zhǔnshí lái kějiàn tā hěn xǐhuan zhèr* — He turns up on time every day, which shows he really likes it here.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

可见 (*kějiàn*) is built from 可 'can' and 见 'to see', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *kenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and the second 'to see'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kějiàn*
- *Say it: kějiàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā měitiān dōu zhǔnshí lái kějiàn tā hěn xǐhuan zhèr* — He turns up on time every day, which shows he really likes it here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to suggest, then the Mandarin for but (in everyday speech), then say *kějiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 可见 mean? ("Which goes to show; so it is clear that".) Say it once more.

365.5 不如 (bùrú) — to do better to; might as well; to be not as good as

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for but (in everyday speech), then the Mandarin for which goes to show.

You'll want to know: 不如

不如 — *bùrú* — "to do better to; might as well; to be not as good as".

我们不如走路去 *wǒmen bùrú zǒulù qù* — We might as well walk.

The tone of bù stays falling here, because the next syllable is not a falling tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不如 (*bùrú*) is built from 不 'not' and 如 'like', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *nyo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'like' and 'as'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùrú*
- *Say it: bùrú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen bùrú zǒulù qù* — We might as well walk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for but (in everyday speech), then the Mandarin for which goes to show, then say *bùrú* again

Before you move on

What does 不如 mean? ("To do better to; might as well; to be not as good as".) Say it once more.

365.6 zhōnggào — word of advice; warning

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for which goes to show, then the Mandarin for might as well.

You'll want to know: zhōnggào

zhōnggào — "word of advice; warning".

nǐ yīnggāi tīng tā de zhōnggào — You should take his advice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhōnggào is built from *zhōng* and *gào*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *kawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'selfless' and the second 'to report'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōnggào*
- *Say it: zhōnggào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yīnggāi tīng tā de zhōnggào* — You should take his advice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for which goes to show, then the Mandarin for might as well, then say *zhōnggào* again

Before you move on

What does zhōnggào mean? ("Word of advice; warning".) Say it once more.

Chapter 366

Take My Advice

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell someone to watch out, keep going and not give up, and say something is worth it.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 366: I can tell someone to watch out, keep going and not give up, and say something is worth it.*

366.1 bìmiǎn — to avoid

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for might as well, then the Mandarin for a word of advice.

You'll want to know: bìmiǎn

bìmiǎn — "to avoid".

> *wǒmen yīnggāi bìmiǎn chūcuò* — We should try not to slip up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bìmiǎn is built from *bì* and *miǎn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjieH* and *mjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn away' and the second 'to stop' and 'to escape'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìmiǎn*
- *Say it: bìmiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi bìmiǎn chūcuò* — We should try not to slip up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for might as well, then the Mandarin for a word of advice, then say *bìmiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does bìmiǎn mean? ("To avoid".) Say it once more.

366.2 当心 (dāngxīn) — to watch out; to look out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a word of advice, then the Mandarin for to avoid.

You'll want to know: 当心

当心 — *dāngxīn* — "to watch out; to look out".

下雨的时候开车必须当心 *xiàyǔ de shíhou kāichē bìxū dāngxīn* — You must take care driving in the rain.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当心 (*dāngxīn*) is built from 当 and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to match' and 'to preside'. How the pair came to mean watching out is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngxīn*
- *Say it: dāngxīn*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ de shíhou kāichē bìxū dāngxīn* — You must take care driving in the rain.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a word of advice, then the Mandarin for to avoid, then say *dāngxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 当心 mean? ("To watch out; to look out".) Say it once more.

366.3 jiānchí — to keep at it; to persist

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to avoid, then the Mandarin for to watch out.

You'll want to know: jiānchí

jiānchí — "to keep at it; to persist".

wǒ juéde xué Hànyǔ yào jiānchí — I think learning Chinese takes perseverance.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiānchí is built from *jiān* and *chí*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ken* and *dri* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'firm' and the second 'to hold'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiānchí*
- *Say it: jiānchí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde xué Hànyǔ yào jiānchí* — I think learning Chinese takes perseverance.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to avoid, then the Mandarin for to watch out, then say *jiānchí* again

Before you move on

What does jiānchí mean? ("To keep at it; to persist".) Say it once more.

366.4 fàngqì — to give up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to watch out, then the Mandarin for to keep at it.

You'll want to know: fàngqì

fàngqì — "to give up".

nǐ bù yīnggāi fàngqì — You shouldn't give up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàngqì is built from *fàng* and *qì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjangH* and *khjijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to drive out' and the second, quoting an older dictionary, 'to throw away'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàngqì*
- *Say it: fàngqì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bù yīnggāi fàngqì* — You shouldn't give up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to watch out, then the Mandarin for to keep at it, then say *fàngqì* again

Before you move on

What does fàngqì mean? ("To give up".) Say it once more.

366.5 zhíde — to be worth it; to be worth doing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep at it, then the Mandarin for to give up.

You'll want to know: zhíde

zhíde — "to be worth it; to be worth doing".

zhè běn shū zhíde kàn — This book is worth reading.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhíde is built from *zhí* and 得 'to get', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *driH* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold' and 'to meet with', and the second 'gain'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíde*
- *Say it: zhíde*, once more
- *Say it: zhè běn shū zhíde kàn* — This book is worth reading.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep at it, then the Mandarin for to give up, then say *zhíde* again

Before you move on

What does zhíde mean? ("To be worth it; to be worth doing".) Say it once more.

Chapter 367

I See What You Mean

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I understand someone, know them well, and find an idea ridiculous.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 367: I can say I understand someone, know them well, and find an idea ridiculous.*

367.1 wùhuì — to get the wrong idea; to misunderstand

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give up, then the Mandarin for to be worth it.

You'll want to know: wùhuì

wùhuì — "to get the wrong idea; to misunderstand".

> *nǐ wùhuì wǒ de yìsi le* — You've misunderstood me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wùhuì is built from *wù* and 会 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nguH* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'an error' and the second 'to come together'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wùhuì*
- *Say it: wùhuì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ wùhuì wǒ de yìsi le* — You've misunderstood me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give up, then the Mandarin for to be worth it, then say *wùhuì* again

Before you move on

What does wùhuì mean? ("To get the wrong idea; to misunderstand".) Say it once more.

367.2 了解 (liǎojiě) — to know in depth; to find out about

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be worth it, then the Mandarin for to get the wrong idea.

You'll want to know: 了解

了解 — *liǎojiě* — "to know in depth; to find out about".

我很了解他 *wǒ hěn liǎojiě tā* — I know him well.

The new character, in pieces: 解 — thirteen strokes in three pieces: on the left a horn piece, seven strokes; on the top right a knife piece, two strokes; on the bottom right a cow piece, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Two third tones meet in this word: liǎo is said with a rising tone before jiě, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

了解 (*liǎojiě*) is built from 了 and 解, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lewX* and *keaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'clever' and 'finished', and the second 'to explain' and 'to loosen'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: liǎojiě*
- *Say it: liǎojiě*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn liǎojiě tā* — I know him well.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be worth it, then the Mandarin for to get the wrong idea, then say *liǎojiě* again

Before you move on

What does 了解 mean? ("To know in depth; to find out about".) Say it once more.

367.3 解 — a horn, a knife and a cow

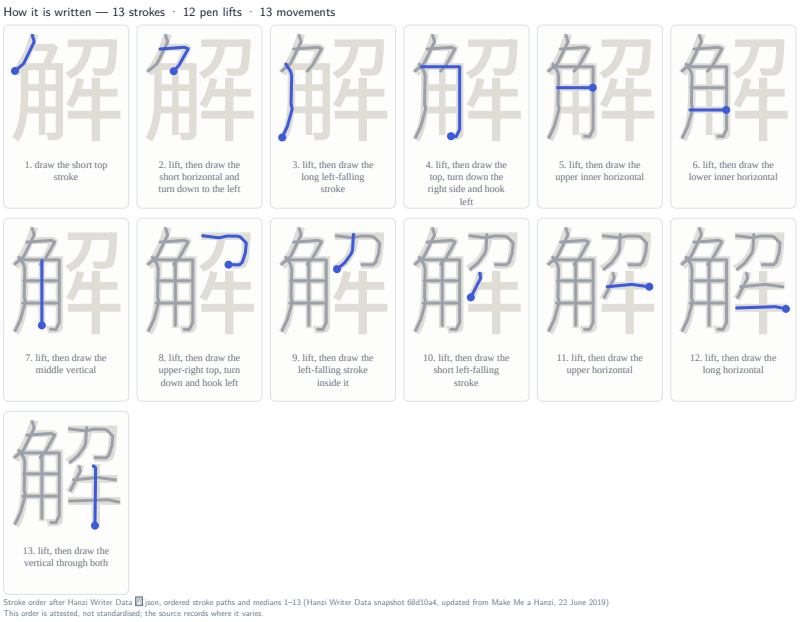
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *liǎojiě* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  了 见

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *le*, *jiàn*

Script — a horn, a knife and a cow



How 解 *is written, stroke by stroke*

解

Three pieces: the horn, then the knife, then the cow. Count three, not thirteen.

The horn piece, seven strokes, on the left: a short left-falling stroke, a horizontal that turns down to the left, a long left-falling stroke down the left side, a horizontal that turns down and hooks, two short horizontals inside, then a vertical down the middle.

The knife piece, two strokes, on the top right: a horizontal that turns down and hooks, then a left-falling stroke inside it.

The cow piece, four strokes, on the bottom right: a short left-falling stroke, a short horizontal, a long horizontal, then a vertical down through them.

7 + 2 + 4 = thirteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 解, all thirteen, with the model in front of you

- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 解? (**Three**: the horn, the knife, the cow.) Which piece comes first? (**The horn, on the left**.) How many strokes does the knife have? (**Two**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 解, pinned stroke paths and medians.

367.4 理解 (lǐjiě) — to understand someone's reasons; to sympathize

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get the wrong idea, then the Mandarin for to know in depth.

You'll want to know: 理解

理解 — *lǐjiě* — "to understand someone's reasons; to sympathize".

> 因为我也当过学生所以我很理解你 *yīnwèi wǒ yě dāng guo xuésheng suǒyǐ wǒ hěn lǐjiě nǐ* — I was a student once too, so I really do understand.

Two third tones meet in this word: lǐ is said with a rising tone before jiě, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

理解 (*lǐjiě*) is built from 理 'order' and 解 'to untie', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *liX* and *keaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to put in order' and the second 'to explain'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǐjiě*

- *Say it: lǐjiě*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi wǒ yě dāng guo xuésheng suǒyǐ wǒ hěn lǐjiě nǐ* — I was a student once too, so I really do understand.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get the wrong idea, then the Mandarin for to know in depth, then say *lǐjiě* again

Before you move on

What does 理解 mean? ("To understand someone's reasons; to sympathize".) Say it once more.

367.5 见解 (jiànjiě) — insight; considered view

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to know in depth, then the Mandarin for to understand someone's reasons.

You'll want to know: 见解

见解 — *jiànjiě* — "insight; considered view".

他的见解很有意思 *tā de jiànjiě hěn yǒu yìsi* — His views are interesting.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

见解 (*jiànjiě*) is built from 见 'to see' and 解 'to untie', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kenH* and *keaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to see' and the second 'to explain'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiànjiě*
- *Say it: jiànjiě*, once more

- *Say it: tā de jiànjiě hěn yǒu yìsi* — His views are interesting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to know in depth, then the Mandarin for to understand someone's reasons, then say *jiànjiě* again

Before you move on

What does 见解 mean? ("Insight; considered view".) Say it once more.

367.6 可笑 (kěxiào) — ridiculous; laughable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to understand someone's reasons, then the Mandarin for an insight.

You'll want to know: 可笑

可笑 — *kěxiào* — "ridiculous; laughable".

我觉得这个问题很可笑 *wǒ juéde zhège wèntí hěn kěxiào* — I think that question is ridiculous.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

可笑 (*kěxiào*) is built from 可 'can' and 笑 'to laugh', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *sjewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and the second 'glad'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěxiào*
- *Say it: kěxiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège wèntí hěn kěxiào* — I think that question is ridiculous.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to understand someone's reasons, then the Mandarin for an insight, then say *kěxiào* again

Before you move on

What does 可笑 mean? ("Ridiculous; laughable".) Say it once more.

Chapter 368

Keep Going

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say at least, name a bad habit, encourage someone and help them choose.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 368: I can say at least, name a bad habit, encourage someone and help them choose.*

368.1 zhìshǎo — at least

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an insight, then the Mandarin for ridiculous.

You'll want to know: zhìshǎo

zhìshǎo — "at least".

> *nǐ zhìshǎo yīnggāi zhǔnshí lái* — You should at least turn up on time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhìshǎo is built from *zhì* and 少 'few', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyijH* and *syewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to arrive' and the second 'not many'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhìshǎo*
- *Say it: zhìshǎo*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zhìshǎo yīnggāi zhǔnshí lái* — You should at least turn up on time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an insight, then the Mandarin for ridiculous, then say *zhìshǎo* again

Before you move on

What does zhìshǎo mean? ("At least".) Say it once more.

368.2 máobìng — fault; bad habit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ridiculous, then the Mandarin for at least.

You'll want to know: máobìng

máobìng — "fault; bad habit".

tā yǒu yí ge xiǎo máobìng — He has one little fault.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

máobìng is built from *máo* and 病 'an illness', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maw* and *bjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'the hair of the brows and the like', and the second 'worry' and 'pain'. How the pair came to mean a fault is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: máobìng*
- *Say it: máobìng*, once more
- *Say it: tā yǒu yí ge xiǎo máobìng* — He has one little fault.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ridiculous, then the Mandarin for at least, then say *máobìng* again

Before you move on

What does máobìng mean? ("Fault; bad habit".) Say it once more.

368.3 了不起 (liǎobuqǐ) — amazing; remarkable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at least, then the Mandarin for a bad habit.

You'll want to know: 了不起

了不起 — *liǎobuqǐ* — "amazing; remarkable".

你真了不起 *nǐ zhēn liǎobuqǐ* — You're amazing.

The tone of bù is lost here: between the two parts it is said light, bu.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

了不起 (*liǎobuqǐ*) is built from 了, 不 'not' and 起 'to rise', all three inherited from Middle Chinese, *lewX*, *pjut* and *khiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'clever' and 'finished' and the third 'to rise'. How the three came to mean remarkable is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: liǎobuqǐ*
- *Say it: liǎobuqǐ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zhēn liǎobuqǐ* — You're amazing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at least, then the Mandarin for a bad habit, then say *liǎobuqǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 了不起 mean? ("Amazing; remarkable".) Say it once more.

368.4 gǔlì — to encourage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bad habit, then the Mandarin for remarkable.

You'll want to know: gǔlì

gǔlì — "to encourage".

lǎoshī chángcháng gǔlì wǒmen — The teacher often encourages us.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǔlì is built from *gǔ* 'a drum' and *lì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *ljejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'to beat a drum', and the second 'to urge on'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔlì*
- *Say it: gǔlì*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī chángcháng gǔlì wǒmen* — The teacher often encourages us.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bad habit, then the Mandarin for remarkable, then say *gǔlì* again

Before you move on

What does gǔlì mean? ("To encourage".) Say it once more.

368.5 xuǎnzé — to make a choice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for remarkable, then the Mandarin for to encourage.

You'll want to know: xuǎnzé

xuǎnzé — "to make a choice".

wǒ juéde nǐ yīnggāi zìjǐ xuǎnzé — I think you should make the choice yourself.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuǎnzé is built from *xuǎn* and *zé*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjwenX* and *draek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each of them 'to choose'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuǎnzé*
- *Say it: xuǎnzé*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde nǐ yīnggāi zìjǐ xuǎnzé* — I think you should make the choice yourself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for remarkable, then the Mandarin for to encourage, then say *xuǎnzé* again

Before you move on

What does xuǎnzé mean? ("To make a choice".) Say it once more.

368.6 Looking back: from Not Allowed to Keep Going

Say the Mandarin for to urge someone and to not allow.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to urge someone, to not allow, a standard to measure by, to give official approval, to remind someone
- *Say it:* to suggest, but (in everyday speech), which goes to show, might as well, a word of advice
- *Say it:* to avoid, to watch out, to keep at it, to give up, to be worth it
- *Say it:* to get the wrong idea, to know in depth, to understand someone's reasons, an insight, ridiculous
- *Say it:* at least, a bad habit, remarkable, to encourage, to make a choice
- *Read it:* 准 可 解 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To urge someone? (*quàn.*) To not allow? (不准, *bùzhǔn.*) A standard to measure by? (*biāozhǔn.*) To give official approval? (*pīzhǔn.*) To remind someone? (*tíxǐng.*) To suggest? (*jiànyì.*) But (in everyday speech)? (可是, *kěshì.*) Which goes to show? (可见, *kějiàn.*) Might as well? (不如, *bùrú.*) A word of advice? (*zhōnggào.*) To avoid? (*bìmiǎn.*) To watch out? (当心, *dāngxīn.*) To keep at it? (*jiānchí.*) To give up? (*fàngqì.*) To be worth it? (*zhíde.*) To get the wrong idea? (*wùhuì.*) To know in depth? (了解, *liǎojiě.*) To understand someone's reasons? (理解, *lǐjiě.*) An insight? (见解, *jiànjiě.*) Ridiculous? (可笑, *kěxiào.*) At least? (*zhìshǎo.*) A bad habit? (*máobìng.*) Remarkable? (了不起, *liǎobuqǐ.*) To encourage? (*gǔlì.*) To make a choice? (*xuǎnzé.*)

Chapter 369

Making It Clear

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can make something clear, give an example, and add a second point and a further one.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 369: I can make something clear, give an example, and add a second point and a further one.*

369.1 说明 (shuōmíng) — to make something clear; to explain clearly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to encourage, then the Mandarin for to make a choice.

You'll want to know: 说明

说明 — *shuōmíng* — "to make something clear; to explain clearly".

> 你必须说明为什么不能准时来 *nǐ bìxū shuōmíng wèishénme bù néng zhǔnshí lái* — You have to explain why you couldn't be on time.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

说明 (*shuōmíng*) is built from 说 'to say' and 明 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sywet* and *mjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tell' and the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuōmíng*
- *Say it: shuōmíng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bìxū shuōmíng wèishénme bù néng zhǔnshí lái* — You have to explain why you couldn't be on time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to encourage, then the Mandarin for to make a choice, then say *shuōmíng* again

Before you move on

What does 说明 mean? ("To make something clear; to explain clearly".) Say it once more.

369.2 但是 (dànshì) — but; however

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a choice, then the Mandarin for to make something clear.

You'll want to know: 但是

但是 — *dànshì* — "but; however".

> 我觉得他很好但是我不喜欢他 *wǒ juéde tā hěn hǎo dànshì wǒ bù xǐhuan tā* — I think he's nice, but I don't like him.

The new character, in pieces: 但 — seven strokes in two pieces: the person piece on the left, two strokes; on the right 日 *rì*, four strokes, over a long bar, five strokes in all. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

但是 (*dànshì*) is built from *dàn* and 是, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *danX* and *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a particle and 'only', and the second 'right, as

against wrong'. How the pair came to mean but is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dànshì*
- *Say it: dànshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde tā hěn hǎo dànshì wǒ bù xǐhuan tā* — I think he's nice, but I don't like him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a choice, then the Mandarin for to make something clear, then say *dànshì* again

Before you move on

What does 但是 mean? ("But; however".) Say it once more.

369.3 但 — the person piece, then the sun over a line

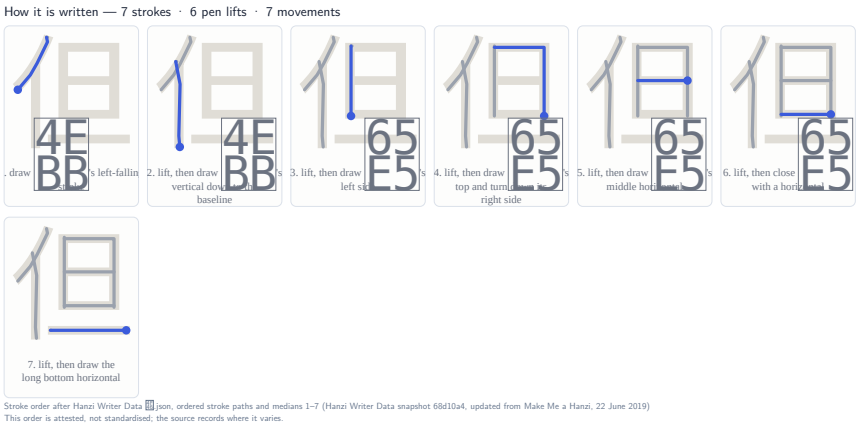
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dànshì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  你 日

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǐ*, *rì*

Script — the person piece, then the sun over a line



How 但 is written, stroke by stroke

但

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 亻, two strokes, as in 你: a left-falling stroke, then a vertical.

The right piece, five strokes: 日, four strokes, a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, a short horizontal inside and the bottom one; then 一, a long horizontal under it, with a little space between.

2 + 5 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 但, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 但? (**Seven.**) What sits on the right? (日 **over** 一.) Which piece comes first? (亻 **, the person piece.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 但, pinned stroke paths and medians.

369.4 jǔlì — to give an example

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make something clear, then the Mandarin for however.

You'll want to know: jǔlì

jǔlì — "to give an example".

nǐ néng jǔlì shuōmíng ma — Can you give an example?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǔlì is built from *jǔ* and *lì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjoX* and *ljejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to lift' and the second 'to compare'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǔlì*
- *Say it: jǔlì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ néng jǔlì shuōmíng ma* — Can you give an example?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make something clear, then the Mandarin for however, then say *jǔlì* again

Before you move on

What does jǔlì mean? ("To give an example".) Say it once more.

369.5 qícì — secondly; second in order

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for however, then the Mandarin for to give an example.

You'll want to know: qícì

qícì — "secondly; second in order".

> *shǒuxiān yīnggāi zhǔnshí qícì yīnggāi yǒu lǐmào* — First, be on time; second, be polite.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qícì is built from *qí* and *cì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gi* and *tshijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a particle and the second 'order' and 'the next'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: qícì*
- *Say it: qícì*, once more
- *Say it: shǒuxiān yīnggāi zhǔnshí qícì yīnggāi yǒu lǐmào* — First, be on time; second, be polite.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for however, then the Mandarin for to give an example, then say *qícì* again

Before you move on

What does qícì mean? ("Secondly; second in order".) Say it once more.

369.6 lìngwài — besides; in addition

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give an example, then the Mandarin for secondly.

You'll want to know: lìngwài

lìngwài — "besides; in addition".

> *zhège tài guì le lìngwài wǒ yě bù xǐhuan* — This one's too expensive, and besides, I don't like it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lìngwài is built from *lìng* 'separate' and 外 'outside'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *ngwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the outside' and 'far'. No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: lìngwài*
- *Say it: lìngwài*, once more
- *Say it: zhège tài guì le lìngwài wǒ yě bù xǐhuan* — This one's too expensive, and besides, I don't like it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give an example, then the Mandarin for secondly, then say *lìngwài* again

Before you move on

What does lìngwài mean? ("Besides; in addition".) Say it once more.

Chapter 370

The Key Point

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a factor and the key point, say what effect something had, and sum up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 370: I can name a factor and the key point, say what effect something had, and sum up.*

370.1 yīnsù — factor

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for secondly, then the Mandarin for in addition.

You'll want to know: yīnsù

yīnsù — "factor".

> *wǒ juéde tiānqì shì yí ge zhòngyào de yīnsù* — I think the weather is an important factor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yīnsù is built from 因 'a cause' and *sù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jin* and *suH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rely on' and 'a cause', and the second 'empty' and 'silk'. How the pair came to mean a factor is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yīnsù*
- *Say it: yīnsù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde tiānqì shì yí ge zhòngyào de yīnsù* — I think the weather is an important factor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for secondly, then the Mandarin for in addition, then say *yīnsù* again

Before you move on

What does yīnsù mean? ("Factor".) Say it once more.

370.2 bìjìng — after all; all things considered

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in addition, then the Mandarin for a factor.

You'll want to know: bìjìng

bìjìng — "after all; all things considered".

tā bìjìng shì háizi — He's only a child, after all.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bìjìng is built from *bì* and *jìng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjit* and *kjaengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the end' and the second 'to use up' and 'the end'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìjìng*
- *Say it: bìjìng*, once more
- *Say it: tā bìjìng shì háizi* — He's only a child, after all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in addition, then the Mandarin for a factor, then say *bìjìng* again

Before you move on

What does bìjìng mean? ("After all; all things considered".) Say it once more.

370.3 guānjiàn — key; crucial point

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a factor, then the Mandarin for all things considered.

You'll want to know: guānjiàn

guānjiàn — "key; crucial point".

wǒ juéde guānjiàn shì shíjiān — I think the key thing is time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guānjiàn is built from 关 'to shut' and *jiàn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaen* and *gjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, quoting an older dictionary, 'a bar across a door', and the second 'a lock'. Middle Chinese *gjen* would regularly give qián; the dictionary also lists the character in the rising tone, which fits jiàn.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānjiàn*
- *Say it: guānjiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde guānjiàn shì shíjiān* — I think the key thing is time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a factor, then the Mandarin for all things considered, then say *guānjiàn* again

Before you move on

What does guānjiàn mean? ("Key; crucial point".) Say it once more.

370.4 作用 (zuòyòng) — effect; function

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all things considered, then the Mandarin for the crucial point.

You'll want to know: 作用

作用 — *zuòyòng* — "effect; function".

我说的话没有作用 *wǒ shuō de huà méiyǒu zuòyòng* — What I said had no effect.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

作用 (*zuòyòng*) is built from 作 'to do' and 用 'to use', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsak* and *youngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to do' and 'to rise', and the second 'to use'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòyòng*
- *Say it: zuòyòng*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ shuō de huà méiyǒu zuòyòng* — What I said had no effect.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all things considered, then the Mandarin for the crucial point, then say *zuòyòng* again

Before you move on

What does 作用 mean? ("Effect; function".) Say it once more.

370.5 zǒngzhī — in short; in a word

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the crucial point, then the Mandarin for the effect something has.

You'll want to know: zǒngzhī

zǒngzhī — "in short; in a word".

zǒngzhī wǒ juéde nǐ yīnggāi qù — In short, I think you should go.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zǒngzhī is built from *zǒng* and *zhī*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsuwngX* and *tsyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to bind together' and 'all', and the second 'to go'. How the pair came to mean in short is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǒngzhī*
- *Say it: zǒngzhī*, once more
- *Say it: zǒngzhī wǒ juéde nǐ yīnggāi qù* — In short, I think you should go.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the crucial point, then the Mandarin for the effect something has, then say *zǒngzhī* again

Before you move on

What does zǒngzhī mean? ("In short; in a word".) Say it once more.

Chapter 371

Although

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say although, go so far as to say even, and draw a conclusion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 371: I can say although, go so far as to say even, and draw a conclusion.*

371.1 shènzhì — even (going so far as)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the effect something has, then the Mandarin for in short.

You'll want to know: shènzhì

shènzhì — "even (going so far as)".

> *tā hěn máng shènzhì méiyǒu shíjiān chī fàn* — He's so busy he hasn't even got time to eat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shènzhì is built from *shèn* and *zhì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyimX* and *tsyijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'excessive' and the second 'to arrive'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shènzhì*
- *Say it: shènzhì*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn máng shènzhì méiyǒu shíjiān chī fàn* — He's so busy he hasn't even got time to eat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the effect something has, then the Mandarin for in short, then say *shènzhì* again

Before you move on

What does shènzhì mean? ("Even (going so far as)".) Say it once more.

371.2 虽然 (suīrán) — although

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in short, then the Mandarin for even (going so far as).

You'll want to know: 虽然

虽然 — *suīrán* — "although".

虽然下雨了但是我们还是去了 *suīrán xiàyǔ le dànshì wǒmen háishi qù le* — Although it rained, we still went.

The new character, in pieces: 虽 — nine strokes in two pieces: 口 *kǒu* on top, and under it an insect piece, six strokes: a small box with a vertical through it, a stroke rising along the foot, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

虽然 (*suīrán*) is built from *suī* and 然, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *swij* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which

glosses the first as a particle and the second as a particle and 'like this'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: suīrán*
- *Say it: suīrán*, once more
- *Say it: suīrán xiàyǔ le dànshì wǒmen háishi qù le* — Although it rained, we still went.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in short, then the Mandarin for even (going so far as), then say *suīrán* again

Before you move on

What does 虽然 mean? ("Although".) Say it once more.

371.3 虽 — a mouth over an insect

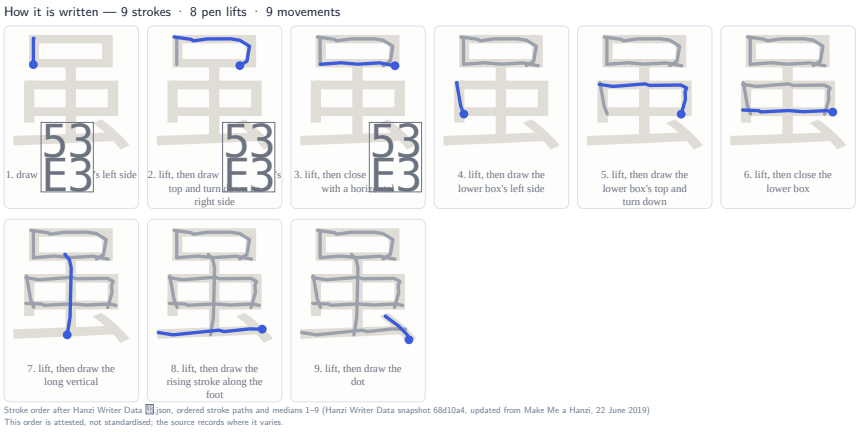
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *suīrán* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 然

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *rán*

Script — a mouth over an insect



How 虽 is written, stroke by stroke

虽

Two pieces, top before bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, 口, three strokes, small: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, the bottom horizontal.

The bottom piece, the insect piece, six strokes: a vertical, a horizontal that turns down, a horizontal closing the small box, a vertical down through it, a stroke rising to the right along the foot, then a dot on the right.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 虽, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 虽? (**Two**.) What is on top? (口.) What is the last stroke? (**A dot on the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 虽, pinned stroke paths and medians.

371.4 jiélùn — conclusion

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for even (going so far as), then the Mandarin for although.

You'll want to know: jiélùn

jiélùn — "conclusion".

wǒ juéde zhège jiélùn bú duì — I don't think that conclusion is right.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiélùn is built from *jié* and *lùn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ket* and *lwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tie' and the second 'to discuss'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiélùn*
- *Say it: jiélùn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège jiélùn bú duì* — I don't think that conclusion is right.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for even (going so far as), then the Mandarin for although, then say *jiélùn* again

Before you move on

What does jiélùn mean? ("Conclusion".) Say it once more.

371.5 zǒngjié — to sum up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for although, then the Mandarin for a conclusion.

You'll want to know: zǒngjié

zǒngjié — "to sum up".

> *lǎoshī zuìhòu zǒngjié le jīntiān de kè* — At the end the teacher summed up the lesson.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zǒngjié is built from *zǒng* and *jié*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsuwngX* and *ket* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to bind together' and the second 'to tie'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǒngjié*
- *Say it: zǒngjié*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī zuìhòu zǒngjié le jīntiān de kè* — At the end the teacher summed up the lesson.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for although, then the Mandarin for a conclusion, then say *zǒngjié* again

Before you move on

What does zǒngjié mean? ("To sum up".) Say it once more.

371.6 yuánzé — principle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a conclusion, then the Mandarin for to sum up.

You'll want to know: yuánzé

yuánzé — "principle".

> *wǒ juéde měi ge rén dōu yīnggāi yǒu yuánzé* — I think everyone should have principles.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuánzé is built from *yuán* and *zé*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwon* and *tsok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a broad plain' and the second 'a rule'. How the first came to mean a source is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuánzé*
- *Say it: yuánzé*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde měi ge rén dōu yīnggāi yǒu yuánzé* — I think everyone should have principles.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a conclusion, then the Mandarin for to sum up, then say *yuánzé* again

Before you move on

What does yuánzé mean? ("Principle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 372

Anyway

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say anyway, ask what on earth someone means, and name someone's strong points.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 372: I can say anyway, ask what on earth someone means, and name someone's strong points.*

372.1 fǎnzhèng — anyway; in any case

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sum up, then the Mandarin for a principle you live by.

You'll want to know: fǎnzhèng

fǎnzhèng — "anyway; in any case".

> *nǐ zuìhǎo bié zháojí fǎnzhèng hái yǒu shíjiān* — Try not to worry; there's still time anyway.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fǎnzhèng is built from *fǎn* and 正 'proper', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjonX* and *tsyengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn over' and the second 'proper'. How the pair came to mean anyway is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fǎnzhèng*
- *Say it: fǎnzhèng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuìhǎo bié zhájí fǎnzhèng hái yǒu shíjiān* — Try not to worry; there's still time anyway.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sum up, then the Mandarin for a principle you live by, then say *fǎnzhèng* again

Before you move on

What does fǎnzhèng mean? ("Anyway; in any case".) Say it once more.

372.2 dàodǐ — on earth (in a question)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a principle you live by, then the Mandarin for anyway.

You'll want to know: dàodǐ

dàodǐ — "on earth (in a question)".

nǐ dàodǐ xiǎng shuō shénme — What on earth are you trying to say?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàodǐ is built from 到 'to arrive' and *dǐ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tawH* and *tejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to arrive' and the second 'below'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàodǐ*
- *Say it: dàodǐ*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ dàodǐ xiǎng shuō shénme* — What on earth are you trying to say?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a principle you live by, then the Mandarin for anyway, then say *dàodǐ* again

Before you move on

What does dàodǐ mean? ("On earth (in a question)".) Say it once more.

372.3 同时 (tóngshí) — simultaneously; at the same moment

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for anyway, then the Mandarin for on earth (in a question).

You'll want to know: 同时

同时 — *tóngshí* — "simultaneously; at the same moment".

他们两个人同时到了 *tāmen liǎng ge rén tóngshí dào le* — The two of them arrived at the same time.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

同时 (*tóngshí*) is built from 同 'the same' and 时 'a time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwng* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'equal' and the second 'a time of day'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóngshí*
- *Say it: tóngshí*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen liǎng ge rén tóngshí dào le* — The two of them arrived at the same time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for anyway, then the Mandarin for on earth (in a question), then say *tóngshí* again

Before you move on

What does 同时 mean? ("Simultaneously; at the same moment".) Say it once more.

372.4 用意 (yòngyì) — intention; the purpose behind it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for on earth (in a question), then the Mandarin for simultaneously.

You'll want to know: 用意

用意 — *yòngyì* — "intention; the purpose behind it".

虽然他没有说但是我明白他的用意 *suīrán tā méiyǒu shuō dànshì wǒ míngbai tā de yòngyì* — He didn't say so, but I understand what he meant by it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

用意 (*yòngyì*) is built from 用 'to use' and 意 'intent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yowngH* and *ʔiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to use' and the second 'will'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yòngyì*
- *Say it: yòngyì*, once more
- *Say it: suīrán tā méiyǒu shuō dànshì wǒ míngbai tā de yòngyì* — He didn't say so, but I understand what he meant by it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for on earth (in a question), then the Mandarin for simultaneously, then say *yòngyì* again

Before you move on

What does 用意 mean? ("Intention; the purpose behind it".) Say it once more.

372.5 yōudiǎn — strong point; merit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for simultaneously, then the Mandarin for the purpose behind it.

You'll want to know: yōudiǎn

yōudiǎn — "strong point; merit".

wǒ juéde zhè shì tā zuì dà de yōudiǎn — I think that's his greatest strength.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yōudiǎn is built from *yōu* and 点 'a point', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'juw* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'abundant' and the second 'a dot'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yōudiǎn*
- *Say it: yōudiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhè shì tā zuì dà de yōudiǎn* — I think that's his greatest strength.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for simultaneously, then the Mandarin for the purpose behind it, then say *yōudiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does yōudiǎn mean? ("Strong point; merit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 373

Pros and Cons

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can weigh up strong and weak points, benefits and harm, and tell someone not to take it seriously.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 373: I can weigh up strong and weak points, benefits and harm, and tell someone not to take it seriously.*

373.1 quēdiǎn — weak point; shortcoming

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the purpose behind it, then the Mandarin for a strong point.

You'll want to know: quēdiǎn

quēdiǎn — "weak point; shortcoming".

> *wǒ juéde měi ge rén dōu yǒu quēdiǎn* — I think everyone has their faults.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

quēdiǎn is built from *quē* and 点 'a point', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khjwiet* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'too little' and, quoting an older dictionary, 'a broken vessel', and the second 'a dot'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: quēdiǎn*
- *Say it: quēdiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde měi ge rén dōu yǒu quēdiǎn* — I think everyone has their faults.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the purpose behind it, then the Mandarin for a strong point, then say *quēdiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does quēdiǎn mean? ("Weak point; shortcoming".) Say it once more.

373.2 hǎochu — benefit; advantage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a strong point, then the Mandarin for a weak point.

You'll want to know: hǎochu

hǎochu — "benefit; advantage".

wǒ juéde měitiān yùndòng yǒu hǎochu — I think exercising every day does you good.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎochu is built from 好 'good' and *chù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *tsyhoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'good' and the second 'a place'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎochu*
- *Say it: hǎochu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde měitiān yùndòng yǒu hǎochu* — I think exercising every day does you good.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a strong point, then the Mandarin for a weak point, then say *hǎochu* again

Before you move on

What does hǎochu mean? ("Benefit; advantage".) Say it once more.

373.3 huàichu — harm; downside

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a weak point, then the Mandarin for a benefit.

You'll want to know: huàichu

huàichu — "harm; downside".

xīyān yǒu shénme huàichu — What harm does smoking do?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huàichu is built from *huài* and *chù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweajH* and *tsyhoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to fall apart of itself' and the second 'a place'. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàichu*
- *Say it: huàichu*, once more
- *Say it: xīyān yǒu shénme huàichu* — What harm does smoking do?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a weak point, then the Mandarin for a benefit, then say *huàichu* again

Before you move on

What does huàichu mean? ("Harm; downside".) Say it once more.

373.4 天真 (tiānzhēn) — naive; innocent

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a benefit, then the Mandarin for a downside.

You'll want to know: 天真

天真 — *tiānzhēn* — "naive; innocent".

虽然你说得有理但是你太天真了 *suīrán nǐ shuō de yǒulǐ dànshì nǐ tài tiānzhēn le* — You may have a point, but you're too naive.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

天真 (*tiānzhēn*) is built from 天 'the sky' and 真 'true', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *then* and *tsyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the dark heaven above' and the second 'true, as against false'. How the pair came to mean naive is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānzhēn*
- *Say it: tiānzhēn*, once more
- *Say it: suīrán nǐ shuō de yǒulǐ dànshì nǐ tài tiānzhēn le* — You may have a point, but you're too naive.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a benefit, then the Mandarin for a downside, then say *tiānzhēn* again

Before you move on

What does 天真 mean? ("Naive; innocent".) Say it once more.

373.5 当真 (dàngzhēn) — to take it seriously; to take at face value

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a downside, then the Mandarin for naive.

You'll want to know: 当真

当真 — *dàngzhēn* — "to take it seriously; to take at face value".

nà shì qìhuà nǐ bié dàngzhēn — Those were angry words; don't take them seriously.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当真 (*dàngzhēn*) is built from 当 and 真 'true', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tangH* and *tsyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be in charge' and the second 'true, as against false'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàngzhēn*
- *Say it: dàngzhēn*, once more
- *Say it: nà shì qìhuà nǐ bié dàngzhēn* — Those were angry words; don't take them seriously.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a downside, then the Mandarin for naive, then say *dàngzhēn* again

Before you move on

What does 当真 mean? ("To take it seriously; to take at face value".) Say it once more.

373.6 Looking back: from Making It Clear to Pros and Cons

Say the Mandarin for to make something clear and however.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to make something clear, however, to give an example, secondly, in addition
- *Say it:* a factor, all things considered, the crucial point, the effect something has, in short
- *Say it:* even (going so far as), although, a conclusion, to sum up, a principle you live by
- *Say it:* anyway, on earth (in a question), simultaneously, the purpose behind it, a strong point
- *Say it:* a weak point, a benefit, a downside, naive, to take it seriously
- *Read it:* 但 虽 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To make something clear? (说明, *shuōmíng.*) However? (但是, *dànshì.*) To give an example? (*jǔlì.*) Secondly? (*qícì.*) In addition? (*lìngwài.*) A factor? (*yīnsù.*) All things considered? (*bìjìng.*) The crucial point? (*guānjiàn.*) The effect something has? (作用, *zuòyòng.*) In short? (*zǒngzhī.*) Even (going so far as)? (*shènzhì.*) Although? (虽然, *suīrán.*) A conclusion? (*jiélùn.*) To sum up? (*zǒngjié.*) A principle you live by? (*yuánzé.*) Anyway? (*fǎnzhèng.*) On earth (in a question)? (*dàodǐ.*) Simultaneously? (同时, *tóngshí.*) The purpose behind it? (用意, *yòngyì.*) A strong point? (*yōudiǎn.*) A weak point? (*quēdiǎn.*) A benefit? (*hǎochu.*) A downside? (*huàichu.*) Naive? (天真, *tiānzhēn.*) To take it seriously? (当真, *dàngzhēn.*)

373.7 Pros and Cons — once more

Say the Mandarin for a weak point and a benefit.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a weak point, a benefit, a downside, naive, to take it seriously

Before you move on

A weak point? (*quēdiǎn.*) A benefit? (*hǎochu.*) A downside? (*huàichu.*) Naive? (天真, *tiānzhēn.*) To take it seriously? (当真, *dàngzhēn.*)

Chapter 374

People and Government

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a population, the government, culture, ethnic groups and how a place develops.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 374: I can talk about a population, the government, culture, ethnic groups and how a place develops.*

374.1 人口 (rénkǒu) — population

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for naive, then the Mandarin for to take it seriously.

You'll want to know: 人口

人口 — *rénkǒu* — "population".

> *zhège chéngshì de rénkǒu yǒu yìqiān wàn* — This city has a population of ten million.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

人口 (*rénkǒu*) is built from 人 'a person' and 口 'a mouth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyin* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'what a person speaks and eats with'. Counting the mouths of a place to mean its people is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: rénkǒu*
- *Say it: rénkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: zhège chéngshì de rénkǒu yǒu yìqiān wàn* — This city has a population of ten million.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for naive, then the Mandarin for to take it seriously, then say *rénkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 人口 mean? ("Population".) Say it once more.

374.2 zhèngfǔ — government

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take it seriously, then the Mandarin for the population (of a place).

You'll want to know: zhèngfǔ

zhèngfǔ — "government".

zhèngfǔ yīnggāi guānxīn lǎo rén — The government should look after old people.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhèngfǔ is built from *zhèng* 'governing' and *fǔ* 'an office', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengH* and *pjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to set right' and the second 'an office of state' and 'a store of documents'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngfǔ*
- *Say it: zhèngfǔ*, once more
- *Say it: zhèngfǔ yīnggāi guānxīn lǎo rén* — The government should look after old people.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take it seriously, then the Mandarin for the population (of a place), then say *zhèngfǔ* again

Before you move on

What does zhèngfǔ mean? ("Government".) Say it once more.

374.3 wénhuà — culture

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the population (of a place), then the Mandarin for the government.

You'll want to know: wénhuà

wénhuà — "culture".

wǒ hěn xǐhuan Zhōngguó wénhuà bǐrú hànzì — I really like Chinese culture, the characters for one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wénhuà is built from 文 'writing' and *huà* 'to transform', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjun* and *xwaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to change' and 'to transform by example'. The sense 'culture' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wénhuà*
- *Say it: wénhuà*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn xǐhuan Zhōngguó wénhuà bǐrú hànzì* — I really like Chinese culture, the characters for one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the population (of a place), then the Mandarin for the government, then say *wénhuà* again

Before you move on

What does wénhuà mean? ("Culture".) Say it once more.

374.4 mínzú — ethnic group; nationality

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the government, then the Mandarin for a people's culture.

You'll want to know: mínzú

mínzú — "ethnic group; nationality".

Zhōngguó yǒu wǔshíliù ge mínzú — China has fifty-six ethnic groups.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mínzú is built from *mín* 'the people' and *zú* 'a clan', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjin* and *dzuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the multitude' and the second 'a lineage'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: mínzú*
- *Say it: mínzú*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngguó yǒu wǔshíliù ge mínzú* — China has fifty-six ethnic groups.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the government, then the Mandarin for a people's culture, then say *mínzú* again

Before you move on

What does mínzú mean? ("Ethnic group; nationality".) Say it once more.

374.5 fāzhǎn — to develop; to expand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a people's culture, then the Mandarin for an ethnic group.

You'll want to know: fāzhǎn

fāzhǎn — "to develop; to expand".

zhège chéngshì fāzhǎn de hěn kuài suǒyǐ fángzi hěn guì — This city is growing fast, so houses are expensive.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāzhǎn is built from *fā* 'to set going' and *zhǎn* 'to open out', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *trjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each with the same word, 'to unfold'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāzhǎn*
- *Say it: fāzhǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège chéngshì fāzhǎn de hěn kuài suǒyǐ fángzi hěn guì* — This city is growing fast, so houses are expensive.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a people's culture, then the Mandarin for an ethnic group, then say *fāzhǎn* again

Before you move on

What does fāzhǎn mean? ("To develop; to expand".) Say it once more.

Chapter 375

Helping Others

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about being poor, society, giving money, volunteers and helping each other.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 375: I can talk about being poor, society, giving money, volunteers and helping each other.*

375.1 qióng — poor (having little money)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an ethnic group, then the Mandarin for to develop and grow.

You'll want to know: qióng

qióng — "poor (having little money)".

> *yǐqián zhèr de rén dōu hěn qióng* — People here used to be poor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qióng is inherited from Middle Chinese *gjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to come to the very end'. How running out came to mean being poor is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: qióng*
- *Say it: qióng*, once more
- *Say it: yǐqián zhèr de rén dōu hěn qióng* — People here used to be poor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an ethnic group, then the Mandarin for to develop and grow, then say *qióng* again

Before you move on

What does qióng mean? ("Poor (having little money)".) Say it once more.

375.2 社会 (shèhuì) — society

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to develop and grow, then the Mandarin for poor (having little money).

You'll want to know: 社会

社会 — *shèhuì* — "society".

wǒmen de shèhuì xūyào rèxīn de rén — Our society needs warm-hearted people.

The new character, in pieces: 社 — seven strokes in two pieces: on the left the sign piece, four strokes; on the right a short bar, a vertical and a long bar, the earth piece at the foot of 在. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

社会 (*shèhuì*) is built from 社 'the altar of the soil' and 会 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyaeX* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which lists the first with the god of grain and glosses the second 'to come together'. People meeting at the village altar is usually given as the start; the sense 'society' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shèhuì*
- *Say it: shèhuì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de shèhuì xūyào rèxīn de rén* — Our society needs warm-hearted people.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to develop and grow, then the Mandarin for poor (having little money), then say *shèhuì* again

Before you move on

What does 社会 mean? ("Society".) Say it once more.

375.3 社 — the sign piece, then the earth piece

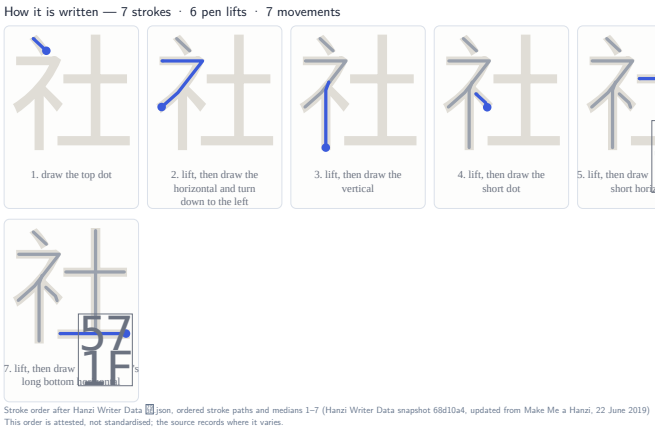
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shèhuì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  在 会

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zài*, *huì*

Script — the sign piece, then the earth piece



How 社 *is written, stroke by stroke*

社

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the sign piece, four strokes. A short dot at the top. A bar that runs right, turns and falls to the lower left, all one stroke. A vertical down from under it. Then a short dot to the right of the vertical.

The right piece, the earth piece, three strokes, as at the foot of 在: a short bar, a vertical down through it, then a long bar across the foot.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 社, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces in 社? (**Two**.) How many strokes in the left piece? (**Four**.) Where have you made the right piece before? (**At the foot of** 在.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 社, pinned stroke paths and medians.

375.4 juān — to donate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for poor (having little money), then the Mandarin for society.

You'll want to know: juān

juān — "to donate".

tā měi nián dōu juān yìxiē qián — He gives some money away every year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

juān is inherited from Middle Chinese *ywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to throw away'. Giving up money for others is the later sense, and it is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: juān*
- *Say it: juān*, once more
- *Say it: tā měi nián dōu juān yìxiē qián* — He gives some money away every year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for poor (having little money), then the Mandarin for society, then say *juān* again

Before you move on

What does juān mean? ("To donate".) Say it once more.

375.5 zhìyuànzhě — volunteer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for society, then the Mandarin for to donate (money).

You'll want to know: zhìyuànzhě

zhìyuànzhě — "volunteer".

> *wǒ xiǎng dāng zhìyuànzhě yīnwèi wǒ xiǎng bāng biérén* — I want to be a volunteer because I want to help other people.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhìyuànzhě is built from *zhì* 'what the heart longs for', *yuàn* 'to wish' and *zhě* 'one who', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyiH*, *ngjwonH* and *tsyaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the last as a grammar word. A volunteer is one who serves of their own will.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhìyuànzhě*
- *Say it: zhìyuànzhě*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng dāng zhìyuànzhě yīnwèi wǒ xiǎng bāng biérén* — I want to be a volunteer because I want to help other people.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for society, then the Mandarin for to donate (money), then say *zhìyuànzhě* again

Before you move on

What does zhìyuànzhě mean? ("Volunteer".) Say it once more.

375.6 hùxiāng — each other; mutually

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to donate (money), then the Mandarin for a volunteer.

You'll want to know: hùxiāng

hùxiāng — "each other; mutually".

> *dàjiā yīnggāi hùxiāng bāngmáng* — Everyone should help each other.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hùxiāng is built from *hù* and *xiāng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huH* and *sjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'interlocking' and the second 'together'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: hùxiāng*
- *Say it: hùxiāng*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā yīnggāi hùxiāng bāngmáng* — Everyone should help each other.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to donate (money), then the Mandarin for a volunteer, then say *hùxiāng* again

Before you move on

What does hùxiāng mean? ("Each other; mutually".) Say it once more.

Chapter 376

Out in Public

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about events, social workers, looking after the park, giving up a seat and square dancing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 376: I can talk about events, social workers, looking after the park, giving up a seat and square dancing.*

376.1 huódòng — an activity; an organised event

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a volunteer, then the Mandarin for each other.

You'll want to know: huódòng

huódòng — "an activity; an organised event".

> *zhège zhōumò gōngyuán lǐ yǒu shénme huódòng* — What's on in the park this weekend?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huódòng is built from *huó* 'alive' and *dòng* 'to move', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwat* and *duwngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'not dead' and the second 'to stir'. The sense 'an event' is later and not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: huódòng*
- *Say it: huódòng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège zhōumò gōngyuán lǐ yǒu shénme huódòng* — What's on in the park this weekend?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a volunteer, then the Mandarin for each other, then say *huódòng* again

Before you move on

What does huódòng mean? ("An activity; an organised event".) Say it once more.

376.2 社工 (shègōng) — social worker

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for each other, then the Mandarin for an organised event.

You'll want to know: 社工

社工 — *shègōng* — "social worker".

我觉得社工的工作很重要 *wǒ juéde shègōng de gōngzuò hěn zhòngyào* — I think social workers do important work.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

社工 (*shègōng*) is built from 社 'society' and 工 'work', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyaeX* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the first with the god of grain and glosses the second 'a craft'. The word is a modern short form of 'social work'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shègōng*
- *Say it: shègōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde shègōng de gōngzuò hěn zhòngyào* — I think social workers do important work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for each other, then the Mandarin for an organised event, then say *shègōng* again

Before you move on

What does 社工 mean? ("Social worker".) Say it once more.

376.3 àihù — to cherish and protect; to treat with care

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an organised event, then the Mandarin for a social worker.

You'll want to know: àihù

àihù — "to cherish and protect; to treat with care".

> *wǒmen yīnggāi àihù gōngyuán lǐ de huācǎo* — We should look after the plants in the park.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

àihù is built from *ài* 'to cherish' and *hù* 'to protect', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'ojH* and *huH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to pity' and the second 'to save' and 'to help'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: àihù*
- *Say it: àihù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi àihù gōngyuán lǐ de huācǎo* — We should look after the plants in the park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an organised event, then the Mandarin for a social worker, then say *àihù* again

Before you move on

What does àihù mean? ("To cherish and protect; to treat with care".) Say it once more.

376.4 ràngzuò — to give up one's seat (to someone)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a social worker, then the Mandarin for to treat with care.

You'll want to know: ràngzuò

ràngzuò — "to give up one's seat (to someone)".

zài dìtiě lǐ niánqīngrén yīnggāi ràngzuò — On the underground, young people should give up their seats.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ràngzuò is built from *ràng* 'to yield' and *zuò* 'a seat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyangH* and *dzwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to give way' and the second 'a bed or a seat'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: ràngzuò*
- *Say it: ràngzuò*, once more
- *Say it: zài dìtiě lǐ niánqīngrén yīnggāi ràngzuò* — On the underground, young people should give up their seats.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a social worker, then the Mandarin for to treat with care, then say *ràngzuò* again

Before you move on

What does ràngzuò mean? ("To give up one's seat (to someone)".) Say it once more.

376.5 guǎngchǎngwǔ — square dancing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to treat with care, then the Mandarin for to give up one's seat.

You'll want to know: guǎngchǎngwǔ

guǎngchǎngwǔ — "square dancing".

> *wǒ māma měitiān wǎnshang dōu qù tiào guǎngchǎngwǔ* — My mum goes square dancing every evening.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Three third tones meet in this word: guǎng and chǎng are both said with a rising tone before wǔ, and the spelling keeps all three marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǎngchǎngwǔ is built from *guǎngchǎng* 'a public square' and *wǔ* 'to dance'. All three parts are inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwangX*, *drjang* and *mjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'wide' and the second 'a threshing floor'. The dancing itself is a custom of recent decades.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǎngchǎngwǔ*
- *Say it: guǎngchǎngwǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma měitiān wǎnshang dōu qù tiào guǎngchǎngwǔ* — My mum goes square dancing every evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to treat with care, then the Mandarin for to give up one's seat, then say *guǎngchǎngwǔ* again

Before you move on

What does guǎngchǎngwǔ mean? ("Square dancing".) Say it once more.

Chapter 377

Our Neighbourhood

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the people who live here, our neighbourhood, a housing estate, what is around it and homes near good schools.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 377: I can talk about the people who live here, our neighbourhood, a housing estate, what is around it and homes near good schools.*

377.1 jūmín — resident (of a place)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give up one's seat, then the Mandarin for square dancing (in a public square).

You'll want to know: jūmín

jūmín — "resident (of a place)".

> *zhèr de jūmín dōu hěn rèxīn* — The people who live here are all very kind.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jūmín is built from *jū* 'to dwell' and *mín* 'the people', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjo* and *mjin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stay' and the second 'the

multitude'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jūmín*
- *Say it: jūmín*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de jūmín dōu hěn rèxīn* — The people who live here are all very kind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give up one's seat, then the Mandarin for square dancing (in a public square), then say *jūmín* again

Before you move on

What does jūmín mean? ("Resident (of a place)".) Say it once more.

377.2 社区 (shèqū) — community; neighbourhood

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for square dancing (in a public square), then the Mandarin for a resident (of a place).

You'll want to know: 社区

社区 — *shèqū* — "community; neighbourhood".

我们社区里有一家书店 *wǒmen shèqū lǐ yǒu yì jiā shūdiàn* — There's a bookshop in our neighbourhood.

The new character, in pieces: 区 — four strokes: a bar across the top, two strokes crossing inside, and a frame down the left and along the foot, open on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

社区 (*shèqū*) is built from 社 'the altar of the soil' and 区 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyaeX* and *khju* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription). The dictionary's entry for the second names a marsh and quotes a note on bent shoots; the sense 'an area' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shèqū*
- *Say it: shèqū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen shèqū lǐ yǒu yì jiā shūdiàn* — There's a bookshop in our neighbourhood.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for square dancing (in a public square), then the Mandarin for a resident (of a place), then say *shèqū* again

Before you move on

What does 社区 mean? ("Community; neighbourhood".) Say it once more.

377.3 区 — a bar, a cross, then the frame

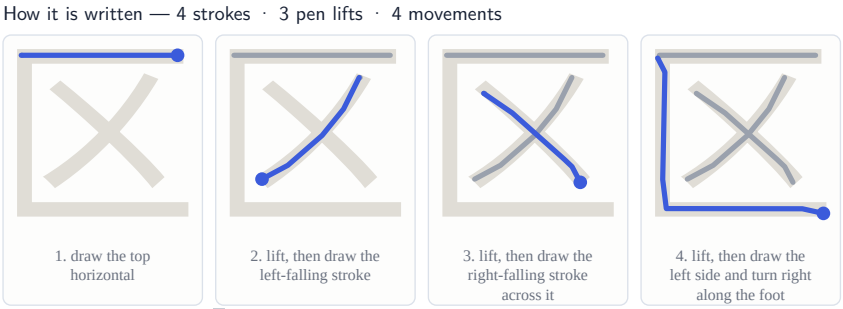
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shèqū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  社 小

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shè*, *xiǎo*

Script — a bar, a cross, then the frame



How ☒ is written, stroke by stroke

☒

Three steps: the top bar, the cross inside, the frame.

The top bar, one stroke, left to right across the top.

The cross inside, two strokes. A stroke falling to the lower left, then a stroke falling to the lower right that crosses it.

The frame, one stroke. A vertical down the left side that turns right along the foot. The right side stays open.

1 + 2 + 1 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ☒, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in ☒? (**Four**.) Which stroke comes last? (**The frame, down the left side and along the foot**.) Which side stays open? (**The right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data ☒, pinned stroke paths and medians.

377.4 小区 (xiǎoqū) — housing estate; residential compound

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a resident (of a place), then the Mandarin for a local community.

You'll want to know: 小区

小区 — *xiǎoqū* — "housing estate; residential compound".

我觉得这个小区很好 *wǒ juéde zhège xiǎoqū hěn hǎo* — I think this estate is very nice.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小区 (*xiǎoqū*) is built from 小 'small' and 区 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'tiny'. A housing estate of many blocks behind one gate is a modern use.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoqū*
- *Say it: xiǎoqū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège xiǎoqū hěn hǎo* — I think this estate is very nice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a resident (of a place), then the Mandarin for a local community, then say *xiǎoqū* again

Before you move on

What does 小区 mean? ("Housing estate; residential compound".) Say it once more.

377.5 zhōuwéi — surroundings; the area around

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a local community, then the Mandarin for a housing estate.

You'll want to know: zhōuwéi

zhōuwéi — "surroundings; the area around".

xiǎoqū zhōuwéi yǒu fàndiàn yě yǒu chāoshì — Round the estate there are restaurants, and a supermarket too.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhōuwéi is built from *zhōu* 'all round' and *wéi* 'to surround', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuw* and *hjw+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go all the way round' and the second 'to encircle'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōuwéi*
- *Say it: zhōuwéi*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoqū zhōuwéi yǒu fàndiàn yě yǒu chāoshì* — Round the estate there are restaurants, and a supermarket too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a local community, then the Mandarin for a housing estate, then say *zhōuwéi* again

Before you move on

What does zhōuwéi mean? ("Surroundings; the area around".) Say it once more.

377.6 学区房 (xuéqūfáng) — a home near a good school

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a housing estate, then the Mandarin for the area around (a place).

You'll want to know: 学区房

学区房 — *xuéqūfáng* — "a home near a good school".

> 大家都想买学区房因为学校好 *dàjiā dōu xiǎng mǎi xuéqūfáng yīnwèi xuéxiào hǎo* — Everyone wants a flat near a good school, because the school is good.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

学区房 (*xuéqūfáng*) is built from 学 'to study', 区 'an area' and 房 'a house', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *haewk*, *khju* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'a room'. A home inside a good school's catchment area is a recent use.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuéqūfáng*
- *Say it: xuéqūfáng*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu xiǎng mǎi xuéqūfáng yīnwèi xuéxiào hǎo* — Everyone wants a flat near a good school, because the school is good.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a housing estate, then the Mandarin for the area around (a place), then say *xuéqūfáng* again

Before you move on

What does 学区房 mean? ("A home near a good school".) Say it once more.

Chapter 378

Noise Next Door

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about noise, complaining, thin walls, strangers at the door and the management office.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 378: I can talk about noise, complaining, thin walls, strangers at the door and the management office.*

378.1 zàoyīn — unwanted noise; din

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the area around (a place), then the Mandarin for a home near a good school.

You'll want to know: zàoyīn

zàoyīn — "unwanted noise; din".

> *wǎnshang wàibian de zàoyīn tài dà le* — The noise outside is far too loud at night.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zàoyīn is built from *zào* 'clamour' and 音 'a sound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sawH* and *'im* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a crowd shouting'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zàoyīn*
- *Say it: zàoyīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang wàibian de zàoyīn tài dà le* — The noise outside is far too loud at night.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the area around (a place), then the Mandarin for a home near a good school, then say *zàoyīn* again

Before you move on

What does zàoyīn mean? ("Unwanted noise; din".) Say it once more.

378.2 bàoyuàn — to complain; to grumble

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a home near a good school, then the Mandarin for unwanted noise.

You'll want to know: bàoyuàn

bàoyuàn — "to complain; to grumble".

línjū bàoyuàn wǒmen tài chǎo le — The neighbours complained that we were too noisy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàoyuàn is built from *bào* 'to hold' and *yuàn* 'resentment', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bawX* and *'jwonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to grasp' and the second 'to resent': holding on to a grudge.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàoyuàn*
- *Say it: bàoyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: línjū bàoyuàn wǒmen tài chǎo le* — The neighbours complained that we were too noisy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a home near a good school, then the Mandarin for unwanted noise, then say *bàoyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does bàoyuàn mean? ("To complain; to grumble".) Say it once more.

378.3 géyīn — soundproofing; soundproof

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for unwanted noise, then the Mandarin for to grumble about.

You'll want to know: géyīn

géyīn — "soundproofing; soundproof".

zhège fángzi de géyīn bù hǎo suǒyǐ hěn chǎo — This house isn't soundproofed well, so it's noisy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

géyīn is built from *gé* 'to block' and 音 'a sound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keak* and *'im* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stop up'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: géyīn*
- *Say it: géyīn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège fángzi de géyīn bù hǎo suǒyǐ hěn chǎo* — This house isn't soundproofed well, so it's noisy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for unwanted noise, then the Mandarin for to grumble about, then say *géyīn* again

Before you move on

What does géyīn mean? ("Soundproofing; soundproof".) Say it once more.

378.4 生人 (shēngrén) — stranger

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to grumble about, then the Mandarin for soundproofing (keeping sound out).

You'll want to know: 生人

生人 — *shēngrén* — "stranger".

晚上有生人来你最好不要开门 *wǎnshang yǒu shēngrén lái nǐ zuìhǎo bú yào kāimén* — If a stranger comes at night, you'd better not open the door.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生人 (*shēngrén*) is built from 生 'raw, new' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to grow'. The sense 'unfamiliar' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngrén*
- *Say it: shēngrén*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang yǒu shēngrén lái nǐ zuìhǎo bú yào kāimén* — If a stranger comes at night, you'd better not open the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to grumble about, then the Mandarin for soundproofing (keeping sound out), then say *shēngrén* again

Before you move on

What does 生人 mean? ("Stranger".) Say it once more.

378.5 wùyè — property management; the management office

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for soundproofing (keeping sound out), then the Mandarin for a stranger.

You'll want to know: wùyè

wùyè — "property management; the management office".

dēng huài le nǐ yīnggāi zhǎo wùyè — If the light's broken, you should call property management.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wùyè is built from *wù* 'a thing' and *yè* 'an undertaking', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjut* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the ten thousand things' and the second 'an affair'. 'Property', and the office that looks after it, are modern senses.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wùyè*
- *Say it: wùyè*, once more
- *Say it: dēng huài le nǐ yīnggāi zhǎo wùyè* — If the light's broken, you should call property management.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for soundproofing (keeping sound out), then the Mandarin for a stranger, then say *wùyè* again

Before you move on

What does wùyè mean? ("Property management; the management office".) Say it once more.

Chapter 379

Feeling Safe

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the stairwell, feeling at ease or uneasy, the door system and law and order.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 379: I can talk about the stairwell, feeling at ease or uneasy, the door system and law and order.*

379.1 lóudào — stairwell; corridor (in a block of flats)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a stranger, then the Mandarin for the property management office.

You'll want to know: lóudào

lóudào — "stairwell; corridor (in a block of flats)".

lóudào lǐ de dēng huài le — The light in the stairwell is broken.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lóudào is built from *lóu* 'a building of several floors' and *dào* 'a way', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luw* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a house on a house' and the second 'a road'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: lóudào*
- *Say it: lóudào*, once more
- *Say it: lóudào lǐ de dēng huài le* — The light in the stairwell is broken.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a stranger, then the Mandarin for the property management office, then say *lóudào* again

Before you move on

What does lóudào mean? ("Stairwell; corridor (in a block of flats)".) Say it once more.

379.2 安心 (ānxīn) — with a mind at rest; settled

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the property management office, then the Mandarin for the stairwell of a block.

You'll want to know: 安心

安心 — *ānxīn* — "with a mind at rest; settled".

这个社区很好我很安心 *zhège shèqū hěn hǎo wǒ hěn ānxīn* — This is a good neighbourhood, and my mind is at rest.

The new character, in pieces: 安 — six strokes: the roof of 家 on top, three strokes, and 女 under it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

安心 (*ānxīn*) is built from 安 'calm' and 心 'the heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'peaceful' and 'to come to rest'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānxīn*
- *Say it: ānxīn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège shèqū hěn hǎo wǒ hěn ānxīn* — This is a good neighbourhood, and my mind is at rest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the property management office, then the Mandarin for the stairwell of a block, then say *ānxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 安心 mean? ("With a mind at rest; settled".) Say it once more.

379.3 安 — the roof of 家, then 女

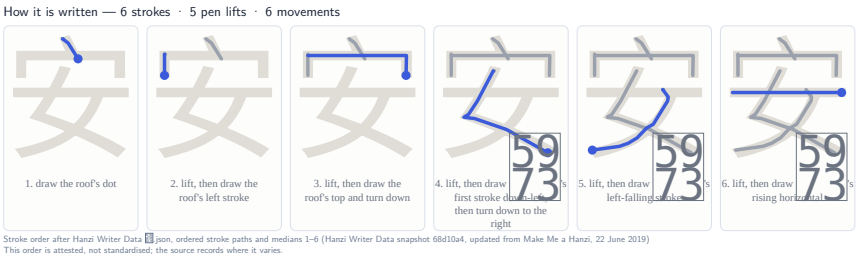
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *ānxīn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

家 女

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jiā*, *nǚ*

Script — the roof of 家, then 女



How 安 is written, stroke by stroke

安

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The roof, three strokes, as on top of 家 and 字: a dot at the top, a short stroke down on the left, then a bar across that turns down at the right end and hooks.

Under the roof, 女, three strokes, as you wrote it: a stroke that falls to the left and turns to the right, a long stroke falling to the left, then a long bar across.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 安, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 安? (**Six**.) What is on top? (**The roof of 家**.) What sits under it? (女.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 安, pinned stroke paths and medians.

379.4 不安 (bù'ān) — uneasy; worried

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the stairwell of a block, then the Mandarin for with a mind at rest.

You'll want to know: 不安

不安 — *bù'ān* — "uneasy; worried".

我一个人在家的时候有点儿不安 *wǒ yí ge rén zài jiā de shíhou yǒudiǎnr bù'ān* — When I'm at home on my own, I feel a little uneasy.

Tone: 不 keeps its own falling tone here, bù, because ān after it is a level tone, not a falling one.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不安 (*bù'ān*) is built from 不 'not' and 安 'calm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *'an* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bù'ān*
- *Say it: bù'ān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yí ge rén zài jiā de shíhou yǒudiǎnr bù'ān* — When I'm at home on my own, I feel a little uneasy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the stairwell of a block, then the Mandarin for with a mind at rest, then say *bù'ān* again

Before you move on

What does 不安 mean? ("Uneasy; worried".) Say it once more.

379.5 ménjìn — door entry system; a card-entry door

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for with a mind at rest, then the Mandarin for uneasy (ill at ease).

You'll want to know: ménjìn

ménjìn — "door entry system; a card-entry door".

wǒmen xiǎoqū yǒu ménjìn suǒyǐ hěn ānquán — Our estate has a door entry system, so it's safe.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ménjìn is built from 門 'a gate' and *jìn* 'to forbid', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mwon* and *kimH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to restrain' and 'to stop'. The card-and-lock system is a modern use.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: ménjìn*
- *Say it: ménjìn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiǎoqū yǒu ménjìn suǒyǐ hěn ānquán* — Our estate has a door entry system, so it's safe.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for with a mind at rest, then the Mandarin for uneasy (ill at ease), then say *ménjìn* again

Before you move on

What does ménjìn mean? ("Door entry system; a card-entry door".) Say it once more.

379.6 zhì'ān — law and order; public order

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for uneasy (ill at ease), then the Mandarin for a card-entry door.

You'll want to know: zhì'ān

zhì'ān — "law and order; public order".

zhèr de zhì'ān hěn hǎo suǒyǐ wǒ hěn fàngxīn — Law and order is good here, so I don't worry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhì'ān is built from *zhì* 'to govern' and 安 'calm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dri* and *'an* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to put in order' and also lists it twice in the departing tone, *drijH* and *driH*, with the same gloss. Mandarin zhì follows a departing reading.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhì'ān*
- *Say it: zhì'ān*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de zhì'ān hěn hǎo suǒyǐ wǒ hěn fàngxīn* — Law and order is good here, so I don't worry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for uneasy (ill at ease), then the Mandarin for a card-entry door, then say *zhì'ān* again

Before you move on

What does zhì'ān mean? ("Law and order; public order".) Say it once more.

379.7 Looking back: from People and Government to Feeling Safe

Say the Mandarin for the population (of a place) and the government.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the population (of a place), the government, a people's culture, an ethnic group, to develop and grow
- *Say it:* poor (having little money), society, to donate (money), a volunteer, each other

- *Say it:* an organised event, a social worker, to treat with care, to give up one's seat, square dancing (in a public square)
- *Say it:* a resident (of a place), a local community, a housing estate, the area around (a place), a home near a good school
- *Say it:* unwanted noise, to grumble about, soundproofing (keeping sound out), a stranger, the property management office
- *Say it:* the stairwell of a block, with a mind at rest, uneasy (ill at ease), a card-entry door, law and order
- *Read it:* 社 区 安 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The population (of a place)? (人口, *rénkǒu.*) The government? (*zhèngfǔ.*) A people's culture? (*wénhuà.*) An ethnic group? (*mínzú.*) To develop and grow? (*fāzhǎn.*) Poor (having little money)? (*qióng.*) Society? (社会, *shèhuì.*) To donate (money)? (*juān.*) A volunteer? (*zhìyuànzhě.*) Each other? (*hùxiāng.*) An organised event? (*huódòng.*) A social worker? (社工, *shègōng.*) To treat with care? (*àihù.*) To give up one's seat? (*ràngzuò.*) Square dancing (in a public square)? (*guǎngchǎngwǔ.*) A resident (of a place)? (*jūmín.*) A local community? (社区, *shèqū.*) A housing estate? (小区, *xiǎoqū.*) The area around (a place)? (*zhōuwéi.*) A home near a good school? (学区房, *xuéqūfáng.*) Unwanted noise? (*zàoyīn.*) To grumble about? (*bàoyuàn.*) Soundproofing (keeping sound out)? (*géyīn.*) A stranger? (生人, *shēngrén.*) The property management office? (*wùyè.*) The stairwell of a block? (*lóudào.*) With a mind at rest? (安心, *ānxīn.*) Uneasy (ill at ease)? (不安, *bù'ān.*) A card-entry door? (*ménjìn.*) Law and order? (*zhì'ān.*)

Chapter 380

Clean Air

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the environment, the air, pollution, the earth and green ways to travel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 380: I can talk about the environment, the air, pollution, the earth and green ways to travel.*

380.1 huánjìng — environment; surroundings

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a card-entry door, then the Mandarin for law and order.

You'll want to know: huánjìng

huánjìng — "environment; surroundings".

> *wǒ juéde zhèr de huánjìng bǐ yǐqián hǎo* — I think the environment here is better than before.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huánjìng is built from *huán* 'a ring' and *jìng* 'a border', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwaen* and *kjaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a jade ring' and the second 'a boundary': what lies around you up to the edge. The modern sense is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: huánjìng*
- *Say it: huánjìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhèr de huánjìng bǐ yǐqián hǎo* — I think the environment here is better than before.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a card-entry door, then the Mandarin for law and order, then say *huánjìng* again

Before you move on

What does huánjìng mean? ("Environment; surroundings".) Say it once more.

380.2 kōngqì — air

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for law and order, then the Mandarin for the environment.

You'll want to know: kōngqì

kōngqì — "air".

yīnwèi xiàyǔ le suǒyǐ kōngqì hěn hǎo — It has rained, so the air is fresh.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kōngqì is built from *kōng* 'empty' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuwng* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'hollow' and the second 'breath'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōngqì*
- *Say it: kōngqì*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi xiàyǔ le suǒyǐ kōngqì hěn hǎo* — It has rained, so the air is fresh.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for law and order, then the Mandarin for the environment, then say *kōngqì* again

Before you move on

What does kōngqì mean? ("Air".) Say it once more.

380.3 wūrǎn — to pollute

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the environment, then the Mandarin for the air we breathe.

You'll want to know: wūrǎn

wūrǎn — "to pollute".

kāichē huì wūrǎn kōngqì — Driving pollutes the air.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wūrǎn is built from *wū* 'dirty water' and *rǎn* 'to dye', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'u* and *nyemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, in another spelling, 'water that stands and does not flow' and the second 'to colour'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wūrǎn*
- *Say it: wūrǎn*, once more
- *Say it: kāichē huì wūrǎn kōngqì* — Driving pollutes the air.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the environment, then the Mandarin for the air we breathe, then say *wūrǎn* again

Before you move on

What does wūrǎn mean? ("To pollute".) Say it once more.

380.4 dìqiú — the earth; our planet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the air we breathe, then the Mandarin for to pollute.

You'll want to know: dìqiú

dìqiú — "the earth; our planet".

dìqiú shì wǒmen dàjiā de jiā — The earth is home to all of us.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìqiú is built from *dì* 'the ground' and *qiú* 'a ball', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the land' and, under another spelling, the second 'a ball of fur that is struck'. The earth as a ball is a later idea.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìqiú*
- *Say it: dìqiú*, once more
- *Say it: dìqiú shì wǒmen dàjiā de jiā* — The earth is home to all of us.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the air we breathe, then the Mandarin for to pollute, then say *dìqiú* again

Before you move on

What does dìqiú mean? ("The earth; our planet".) Say it once more.

380.5 huánbǎo — eco-friendly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pollute, then the Mandarin for our planet.

You'll want to know: huánbǎo

huánbǎo — "eco-friendly".

zuò dìtiě bǐ kāichē huánbǎo — Taking the underground is greener than driving.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huánbǎo is built from *huán*, the first syllable of *huánjìng* 'the environment', and *bǎo* 'to keep', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwaen* and *pawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to guard': a short form of 'protecting the environment'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: huánbǎo*
- *Say it: huánbǎo*, once more
- *Say it: zuò dìtiě bǐ kāichē huánbǎo* — Taking the underground is greener than driving.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pollute, then the Mandarin for our planet, then say *huánbǎo* again

Before you move on

What does huánbǎo mean? ("Eco-friendly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 381

The Whole Family

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about sorting rubbish, the whole family, recycling, the whole country and feeling safe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 381: I can talk about sorting rubbish, the whole family, recycling, the whole country and feeling safe.*

381.1 fēnlèi — to sort into kinds

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for our planet, then the Mandarin for eco-friendly (good for the environment).

You'll want to know: fēnlèi

fēnlèi — "to sort into kinds".

> *lājī yīnggāi fēnlèi* — Rubbish should be sorted.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēnlèi is built from *fēn* 'to divide' and *lèi* 'a kind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjun* and *lwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to separate' and the second 'a sort'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēnlèi*
- *Say it: fēnlèi*, once more
- *Say it: lājī yīnggāi fēnlèi* — Rubbish should be sorted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for our planet, then the Mandarin for eco-friendly (good for the environment), then say *fēnlèi* again

Before you move on

What does fēnlèi mean? ("To sort into kinds".) Say it once more.

381.2 全家 (quánjiā) — the whole family

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for eco-friendly (good for the environment), then the Mandarin for to sort into kinds.

You'll want to know: 全家

全家 — *quánjiā* — "the whole family".

今天我们全家一起打扫房子 *jīntiān wǒmen quánjiā yìqǐ dǎsǎo fángzi* — Today the whole family is cleaning the house together.

The new character, in pieces: 全 — six strokes: a wide roof like 人, then a bar, a second bar, a vertical down from the first through the second, and a long bar at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

全家 (*quánjiā*) is built from 全 'whole' and 家 'a home', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjwen* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'complete'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: quánjiā*
- *Say it: quánjiā*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒmen quánjiā yìqǐ dǎsǎo fángzi* — Today the whole family is cleaning the house together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for eco-friendly (good for the environment), then the Mandarin for to sort into kinds, then say *quánjiā* again

Before you move on

What does 全家 mean? ("The whole family".) Say it once more.

381.3 全 — a wide roof, then three bars and a vertical

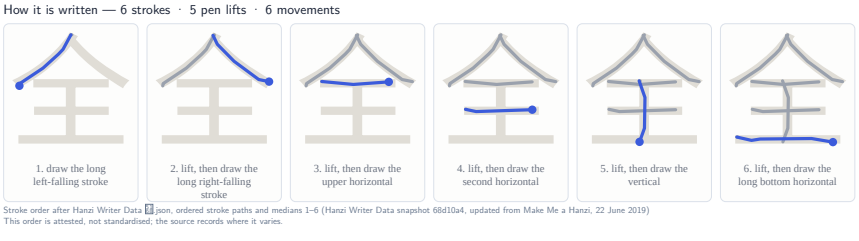
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *quánjiā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  人 安

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *ān*

Script — a wide roof, then three bars and a vertical



How 全 is written, stroke by stroke

全

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The roof, two strokes, like 人 opened wide: a long stroke falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the right from near its top.

Under it, four strokes. A bar. A second bar under it. A vertical down from the first bar through the second. Then a long bar across the foot.

2 + 4 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 全, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 全? (**Six**.) What is the roof like? (**人, opened wide**.) Which stroke comes after the two bars? (**The vertical**.) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 全, pinned stroke paths and medians.

381.4 huíshōu — to recycle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sort into kinds, then the Mandarin for the whole family.

You'll want to know: huíshōu

huíshōu — "to recycle".

zhèxiē píngzi yīnggāi huíshōu yīnwèi hái néng yòng — These bottles should be recycled, because they can still be used.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huíshōu is built from 回 'to turn back' and *shōu* 'to gather', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *syuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to collect'. Recycling is a modern sense.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: huíshōu*
- *Say it: huíshōu*, once more
- *Say it: zhèxiē píngzi yīnggāi huíshōu yīnwèi hái néng yòng* — These bottles should be recycled, because they can still be used.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sort into kinds, then the Mandarin for the whole family, then say *huíshōu* again

Before you move on

What does huíshōu mean? ("To recycle".) Say it once more.

381.5 全国 (quánguó) — the whole country; nationwide

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the whole family, then the Mandarin for to recycle.

You'll want to know: 全国

全国 — *quánguó* — "the whole country; nationwide".

今天全国都很冷 *jīntiān quánguó dōu hěn lěng* — It's cold all over the country today.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

全国 (*quánguó*) is built from 全 'whole' and 国 'a country', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjwen* and *kwok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a state'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: quánguó*
- *Say it: quánguó*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān quánguó dōu hěn lěng* — It's cold all over the country today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the whole family, then the Mandarin for to recycle, then say *quánguó* again

Before you move on

What does 全国 mean? ("The whole country; nationwide".) Say it once more.

381.6 安全感 (ānquángǎn) — a sense of security

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to recycle, then the Mandarin for nationwide.

You'll want to know: 安全感

安全感 — *ānquángǎn* — "a sense of security".

在这个小区里我很有安全感 *zài zhège xiǎoqū lǐ wǒ hěn yǒu ānquángǎn* — In this estate I feel really safe.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

安全感 (*ānquángǎn*) is built from 安全 'safe' and 感 'to feel', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an*, *dzjwen* and *komX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'to move'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānquángǎn*
- *Say it: ānquángǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zài zhège xiǎoqū lǐ wǒ hěn yǒu ānquángǎn* — In this estate I feel really safe.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to recycle, then the Mandarin for nationwide, then say *ānquángǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 安全感 mean? ("A sense of security".) Say it once more.

Chapter 382

The Security Guard

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about being on duty, security guards, cameras, promising and patrols.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 382: I can talk about being on duty, security guards, cameras, promising and patrols.*

382.1 zhíbān — to be on duty

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for nationwide, then the Mandarin for a sense of security.

You'll want to know: zhíbān

zhíbān — "to be on duty".

> *jīntiān wǎnshang wǒ zhíbān* — I'm on duty tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhíbān is built from *zhí* 'to meet, to hold' and *bān* 'a turn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *driH* and *paen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold' and 'to meet with' and the second 'to hand out tokens'. The sense 'a shift' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíbān*
- *Say it: zhíbān*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǎnshang wǒ zhíbān* — I'm on duty tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for nationwide, then the Mandarin for a sense of security, then say *zhíbān* again

Before you move on

What does zhíbān mean? ("To be on duty".) Say it once more.

382.2 保安 (bǎo'ān) — security guard

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sense of security, then the Mandarin for to be on duty.

You'll want to know: 保安

保安 — *bǎo'ān* — "security guard".

小区门口有两个保安 *xiǎoqū ménkǒu yǒu liǎng ge bǎo'ān* — There are two security guards at the gate of the estate.

The new character, in pieces: 保 — nine strokes in three pieces: the person piece 亻, then 口 high on the right over a tree of four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

保安 (*bǎo'ān*) is built from 保 'to keep' and 安 'calm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *'an* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to guard' and 'to keep safe': keeping the peace, and then the person who does it.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎo'ān*
- *Say it: bǎo'ān*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoqū ménkǒu yǒu liǎng ge bǎo'ān* — There are two security guards at the gate of the estate.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sense of security, then the Mandarin for to be on duty, then say *bǎo'ān* again

Before you move on

What does 保安 mean? ("Security guard".) Say it once more.

382.3 保 — the person piece, then 口 over a tree

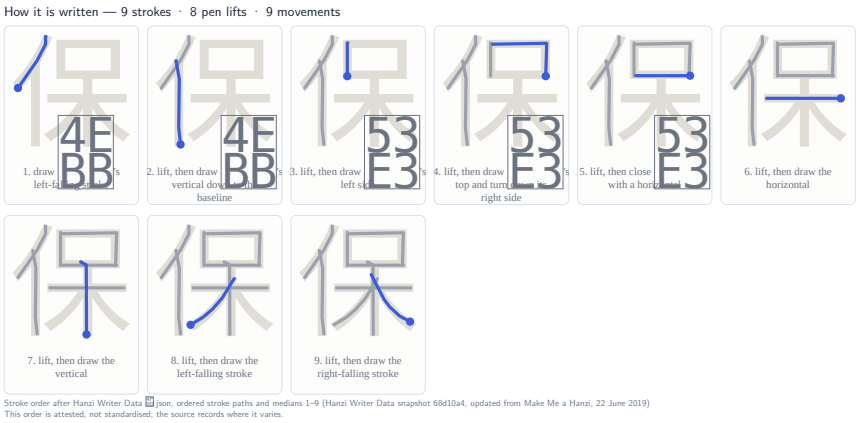
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bǎo'ān* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  你 安

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǐ*, *ān*

Script — the person piece, then 口 over a tree



How 保 is written, stroke by stroke

保

Three pieces: the person piece on the left, then 口 over a tree on the right.

The person piece 亻, two strokes, as in 你 and 他.

口, three strokes, high on the right: a short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, then the bar that closes the foot.

The tree under it, four strokes. A long bar. A vertical down through it. A stroke falling to the left from the crossing, then one falling to the right.

2 + 3 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 保, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 保? (**Nine.**) What sits over the tree? (口.) Which piece comes first? (**亻, the person piece.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 保, pinned stroke paths and medians.

382.4 jiānkòng — security camera; CCTV

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be on duty, then the Mandarin for a security guard.

You'll want to know: jiānkòng

jiānkòng — "security camera; CCTV".

yīnwèi yǒu jiānkòng suǒyǐ xiǎoqū lǐ hěn ānquán — There are cameras, so the estate is safe.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiānkòng is built from *jiān* 'to watch over' and *kòng* 'to pull', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaem* and *khuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to look down on and inspect' and the second 'to draw' and 'to report'. The camera is a modern sense.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiānkòng*
- *Say it: jiānkòng*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi yǒu jiānkòng suǒyǐ xiǎoqū lǐ hěn ānquán* — There are cameras, so the estate is safe.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be on duty, then the Mandarin for a security guard, then say *jiānkòng* again

Before you move on

What does jiānkòng mean? ("Security camera; CCTV".) Say it once more.

382.5 bǎozhèng — to promise; to guarantee

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a security guard, then the Mandarin for a security camera.

You'll want to know: bǎozhèng

bǎozhèng — "to promise; to guarantee".

wǒ bǎozhèng yǐhòu bú zhème chǎo le — I promise I won't be this noisy again.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎozhèng is built from *bǎo* 'to keep' and *zhèng* 'to prove', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *tsyingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to answer for' and the second 'to test'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎozhèng*
- *Say it: bǎozhèng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bǎozhèng yǐhòu bú zhème chǎo le* — I promise I won't be this noisy again.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a security guard, then the Mandarin for a security camera, then say *bǎozhèng* again

Before you move on

What does bǎozhèng mean? ("To promise; to guarantee".) Say it once more.

382.6 xúnluó — to patrol

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a security camera, then the Mandarin for to guarantee.

You'll want to know: xúnluó

xúnluó — "to patrol".

wǎnshang bǎo'ān yīnggāi zài xiǎoqū lǐ xúnluó — At night the guards should patrol the estate.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xúnluó is built from *xún* 'to go round' and *luó* 'a patrol', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zwin* and *laH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go about looking' and the second 'roving soldiers'. Mandarin luó has a rising tone where the dictionary gives a departing one.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xúnluó*
- *Say it: xúnluó*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang bǎo'ān yīnggāi zài xiǎoqū lǐ xúnluó* — At night the guards should patrol the estate.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a security camera, then the Mandarin for to guarantee, then say *xúnluó* again

Before you move on

What does xúnluó mean? ("To patrol".) Say it once more.

Chapter 383

Saving Energy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the electricity bill, wasting things, energy, cutting down and throwaway things.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 383: I can talk about the electricity bill, wasting things, energy, cutting down and throwaway things.*

383.1 diànfèi — electricity bill

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to guarantee, then the Mandarin for to patrol.

You'll want to know: diànfèi

diànfèi — "electricity bill".

> *xiàtiān kāi kōngtiáo diànfèi hěn guì* — In summer, with the air conditioning on, the electricity bill is high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diànfèi is built from 电 'electricity' and *fèi* 'a cost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *denH* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'lightning' and the second 'to use up'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: diànfèi*
- *Say it: diànfèi*, once more
- *Say it: xiàtiān kāi kōngtiáo diànfèi hěn guì* — In summer, with the air conditioning on, the electricity bill is high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to guarantee, then the Mandarin for to patrol, then say *diànfèi* again

Before you move on

What does diànfèi mean? ("Electricity bill".) Say it once more.

383.2 làngfèi — to waste

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to patrol, then the Mandarin for the electricity bill.

You'll want to know: làngfèi

làngfèi — "to waste".

xǐzǎo de shíhou bú yào làngfèi shuǐ — Don't waste water when you have a shower.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

làngfèi is built from *làng* 'a wave' and *fèi* 'to use up', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *langH* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a wave; reckless' and the second 'to spend down'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: làngfèi*
- *Say it: làngfèi*, once more
- *Say it: xǐzǎo de shíhou bú yào làngfèi shuǐ* — Don't waste water when you have a shower.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to patrol, then the Mandarin for the electricity bill, then say *làngfèi* again

Before you move on

What does làngfèi mean? ("To waste".) Say it once more.

383.3 néngyuán — energy; sources of energy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the electricity bill, then the Mandarin for to waste.

You'll want to know: néngyuán

néngyuán — "energy; sources of energy".

yīnwèi néngyuán hěn guì suǒyǐ diànfèi yě hěn guì — Energy is expensive, so the electricity bill is high too.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

néngyuán is built from 能 'able' and *yuán* 'a source', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nong* and *ngjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'skilled' and the second 'where water rises'. Energy as power for machines is a modern sense.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: néngyuán*
- *Say it: néngyuán*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi néngyuán hěn guì suǒyǐ diànfèi yě hěn guì* — Energy is expensive, so the electricity bill is high too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the electricity bill, then the Mandarin for to waste, then say *néngyuán* again

Before you move on

What does néngyuán mean? ("Energy; sources of energy".) Say it once more.

383.4 jiǎnshǎo — to reduce; to cut down

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to waste, then the Mandarin for sources of energy.

You'll want to know: jiǎnshǎo

jiǎnshǎo — "to reduce; to cut down".

zuò dìtiě kěyǐ jiǎnshǎo dǔchē — Taking the underground can cut down on traffic jams.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: jiǎn is said with a rising tone before shǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎnshǎo is built from *jiǎn* 'to lessen' and 少 'few', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keamX* and *syewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to diminish' and the second 'not

many'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎnshǎo*
- *Say it: jiǎnshǎo*, once more
- *Say it: zuò dìtiě kěyǐ jiǎnshǎo dǔchē* — Taking the underground can cut down on traffic jams.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to waste, then the Mandarin for sources of energy, then say *jiǎnshǎo* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎnshǎo mean? ("To reduce; to cut down".) Say it once more.

383.5 yícìxìng — disposable; used once

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sources of energy, then the Mandarin for to cut down on.

You'll want to know: yícìxìng

yícìxìng — "disposable; used once".

wǒmen zuìhǎo bú yòng yícìxìng kuàizi — We'd better not use disposable chopsticks.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Tone: 一 is said yí here, rising, because cì after it is a falling tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yícìxìng is built from 一 'one', *cì* 'a time' and *xìng* 'nature', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit*, *tshijH* and *sjengH* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a stopping place' and 'an order'. The word is modern.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yícìxìng*
- *Say it: yícìxìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuìhǎo bú yòng yícìxìng kuàizi* — We'd better not use disposable chopsticks.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sources of energy, then the Mandarin for to cut down on, then say *yícìxìng* again

Before you move on

What does yícìxìng mean? ("Disposable; used once".) Say it once more.

Chapter 384

Becoming Green

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about planting trees, becoming something, what things cost to make, resources and growth.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 384: I can talk about planting trees, becoming something, what things cost to make, resources and growth.*

384.1 zhòngshù — to plant trees

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to cut down on, then the Mandarin for disposable (used once).

You'll want to know: zhòngshù

zhòngshù — "to plant trees".

> *měi nián chūntiān wǒmen dōu qù shān lǐ zhòngshù* — Every spring we go to the hills to plant trees.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhòngshù is built from *zhòng* 'to plant' and *shù* 'a tree', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyowngH* and *dzyuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'trees as a whole' and 'to set up'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòngshù*
- *Say it: zhòngshù*, once more
- *Say it: měi nián chūntiān wǒmen dōu qù shān lǐ zhòngshù* — Every spring we go to the hills to plant trees.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to cut down on, then the Mandarin for disposable (used once), then say *zhòngshù* again

Before you move on

What does zhòngshù mean? ("To plant trees".) Say it once more.

384.2 成为 (chéngwéi) — to become

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for disposable (used once), then the Mandarin for to plant trees.

You'll want to know: 成为

成为 — *chéngwéi* — "to become".

他想成为一个医生 *tā xiǎng chéngwéi yí ge yīshēng* — He wants to become a doctor.

The new character, in pieces: 成 — six strokes: a short bar, a long stroke falling to the left, a small turning hook, the long slanting hook of 我, a short fall and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成为 (*chéngwéi*) is built from 成 'to complete' and 为 'to make', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *hjwe* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to finish' and the second 'to do'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngwéi*
- *Say it: chéngwéi*, once more
- *Say it: tā xiǎng chéngwéi yí ge yīshēng* — He wants to become a doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for disposable (used once), then the Mandarin for to plant trees, then say *chéngwéi* again

Before you move on

What does 成为 mean? ("To become".) Say it once more.

384.3 成 — a bar, a fall, a small turn, then the slanting hook of 我

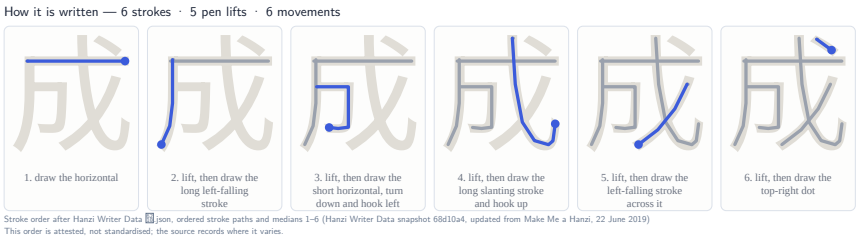
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chéngwéi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  我 为

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wǒ*, *wéi*

Script — a bar, a fall, a small turn, then the slanting hook of 我



How 成 is written, stroke by stroke

成

One shape, six strokes in a fixed order. The order is the thing to hold.

A bar, left to right, from the left edge to past the middle.

A long stroke falling to the left from the left end of the bar down to the foot.

A small turning hook under the bar: a short bar that turns down and hooks to the left.

The long slanting hook, as in 我: from the top, a long stroke down to the lower right that flicks up at the end. Then **a short stroke falling to the left** across it, and **a dot** at the upper right.

Six strokes in all.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 成, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 成? (**Six.**) Which stroke flicks up at the end? (**The long slanting hook, the fourth.**) What comes last? (**The dot at the upper right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 成, pinned stroke paths and medians.

384.4 成本 (chéngběn) — production cost; cost

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to plant trees, then the Mandarin for to become.

You'll want to know: 成本

成本 — *chéngběn* — "production cost; cost".

请保安的成本很高 *qǐng bǎo'ān de chéngběn hěn gāo* — It costs a lot to hire security guards.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成本 (*chéngběn*) is built from **成** 'to complete' and **本** 'the root', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *pwonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the foot of a tree': what a finished thing rests on. The sense 'cost' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngběn*
- *Say it: chéngběn*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng bǎo'ān de chéngběn hěn gāo* — It costs a lot to hire security guards.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to plant trees, then the Mandarin for to become, then say *chéngběn* again

Before you move on

What does **成本** mean? ("Production cost; cost".) Say it once more.

384.5 zīyuán — natural resources

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to become, then the Mandarin for production cost.

You'll want to know: zīyuán

zīyuán — "natural resources".

> *shuǐ shì hěn zhòngyào de zīyuán suǒyǐ wǒmen bù yīnggāi làngfèi* — Water is a very important resource, so we shouldn't waste it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zīyuán is built from *zī* 'goods' and *yuán* 'a source', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsij* and *ngjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'wealth' and 'to help' and the second 'where water rises'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zīyuán*
- *Say it: zīyuán*, once more
- *Say it: shuǐ shì hěn zhòngyào de zīyuán suǒyǐ wǒmen bù yīnggāi làngfèi* — Water is a very important resource, so we shouldn't waste it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to become, then the Mandarin for production cost, then say *zīyuán* again

Before you move on

What does zīyuán mean? ("Natural resources".) Say it once more.

384.6 zēngjiā — to increase

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for production cost, then the Mandarin for natural resources.

You'll want to know: zēngjiā

zēngjiā — "to increase".

> *yīnwèi rénkǒu zēngjiā le suǒyǐ fángzi hěn guì* — The population has grown, so houses are expensive.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zēngjiā is built from *zēng* and *jiā*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsong* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each with the other: 'to add'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zēngjiā*
- *Say it: zēngjiā*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi rénkǒu zēngjiā le suǒyǐ fángzi hěn guì* — The population has grown, so houses are expensive.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for production cost, then the Mandarin for natural resources, then say *zēngjiā* again

Before you move on

What does zēngjiā mean? ("To increase".) Say it once more.

Chapter 385

Good Reasons

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about raising prices, what is most likely, saving energy, taking things seriously and ways of living.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 385: I can talk about raising prices, what is most likely, saving energy, taking things seriously and ways of living.*

385.1 tígāo — to push up (a level)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for natural resources, then the Mandarin for to increase (in number).

You'll want to know: tígāo

tígāo — "to push up (a level)".

> *zhè jiā fàndiàn tígāo le jiàqián* — This restaurant has put its prices up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tígāo is built from *tí* 'to carry by the handle' and 高 'high', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dej* and *kaw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to carry in the hand'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: tígāo*
- *Say it: tígāo*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fàndiàn tígāo le jiàqián* — This restaurant has put its prices up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for natural resources, then the Mandarin for to increase (in number), then say *tígāo* again

Before you move on

What does tígāo mean? ("To push up (a level)".) Say it once more.

385.2 八成 (bāchéng) — most likely; eighty per cent

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to increase (in number), then the Mandarin for to push up (a level).

You'll want to know: 八成

八成 — *bāchéng* — "most likely; eighty per cent".

他八成病了所以没来 *tā bāchéng bìng le suǒyǐ méi lái* — He's most likely ill, which is why he didn't come.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

八成 (*bāchéng*) is built from 八 'eight' and 成 'a tenth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *peat* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'to complete'; 成 for one part in ten is later and is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāchéng*
- *Say it: bāchéng*, once more
- *Say it: tā bāchéng bìng le suǒyǐ méi lái* — He's most likely ill, which is why he didn't come.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to increase (in number), then the Mandarin for to push up (a level), then say *bāchéng* again

Before you move on

What does 八成 mean? ("Most likely; eighty per cent".) Say it once more.

385.3 节能 (jiénéng) — to save energy; energy-saving

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to push up (a level), then the Mandarin for most likely (eight in ten).

You'll want to know: 节能

节能 — *jiénéng* — "to save energy; energy-saving".

> 我觉得坐火车比开车节能 *wǒ juéde zuò huǒchē bǐ kāichē jiénéng* — I think taking the train saves more energy than driving.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

节能 (*jiénéng*) is built from 节 'to restrain' and 能 'energy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tset* and *nong* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the joint of a bamboo' and 'to hold back'. The word is modern.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiénéng*
- *Say it: jiénéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zuò huǒchē bǐ kāichē jiénéng* — I think taking the train saves more energy than driving.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to push up (a level), then the Mandarin for most likely (eight in ten), then say *jiénéng* again

Before you move on

What does 节能 mean? ("To save energy; energy-saving".) Say it once more.

385.4 zhòngshì — to attach importance to

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for most likely (eight in ten), then the Mandarin for to save energy.

You'll want to know: zhòngshì

zhòngshì — "to attach importance to".

zhèngfǔ yīnggāi zhòngshì huánjìng — The government should take the environment seriously.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhòngshì is built from 重 'heavy' and *shì* 'to look at', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjowngX* and *dzyijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'thick' and 'careful' and the second 'to look'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòngshì*
- *Say it: zhòngshì*, once more
- *Say it: zhèngfǔ yīnggāi zhòngshì huánjìng* — The government should take the environment seriously.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for most likely (eight in ten), then the Mandarin for to save energy, then say *zhòngshì* again

Before you move on

What does zhòngshì mean? ("To attach importance to".) Say it once more.

385.5 fāngshì — a way of doing things; a mode

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to save energy, then the Mandarin for to attach importance to.

You'll want to know: fāngshì

fāngshì — "a way of doing things; a mode".

qí zìxíngchē shì yí ge hěn huánbǎo de fāngshì — Cycling is a very green way to get about.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāngshì is built from *fāng* 'a method' and *shì* 'a pattern', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjang* and *syik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'square' and 'a method' and the second 'a rule'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāngshì*
- *Say it: fāngshì*, once more
- *Say it: qí zìxíngchē shì yí ge hěn huánbǎo de fāngshì* — Cycling is a very green way to get about.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to save energy, then the Mandarin for to attach importance to, then say *fāngshì* again

Before you move on

What does fāngshì mean? ("A way of doing things; a mode".) Say it once more.

385.6 Looking back: from Clean Air to Good Reasons

Say the Mandarin for the environment and the air we breathe.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the environment, the air we breathe, to pollute, our planet, eco-friendly (good for the environment)
- *Say it:* to sort into kinds, the whole family, to recycle, nationwide, a sense of security
- *Say it:* to be on duty, a security guard, a security camera, to guarantee, to patrol
- *Say it:* the electricity bill, to waste, sources of energy, to cut down on, disposable (used once)
- *Say it:* to plant trees, to become, production cost, natural resources, to increase (in number)

- *Say it:* to push up (a level), most likely (eight in ten), to save energy, to attach importance to, a way of doing things
- *Read it:* 全 保 成 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The environment? (*huánjìng.*) The air we breathe? (*kōngqì.*) To pollute? (*wūrǎn.*) Our planet? (*dìqiú.*) Eco-friendly (good for the environment)? (*huánbǎo.*) To sort into kinds? (*fēnlèi.*) The whole family? (全家, *quánjiā.*) To recycle? (*huíshōu.*) Nationwide? (全国, *quánguó.*) A sense of security? (安全感, *ānquángǎn.*) To be on duty? (*zhíbān.*) A security guard? (保安, *bǎo'ān.*) A security camera? (*jiānkòng.*) To guarantee? (*bǎozhèng.*) To patrol? (*xúnluó.*) The electricity bill? (*diànfèi.*) To waste? (*làngfèi.*) Sources of energy? (*néngyuán.*) To cut down on? (*jiǎnshǎo.*) Disposable (used once)? (*yícìxìng.*) To plant trees? (*zhòngshù.*) To become? (成为, *chéngwéi.*) Production cost? (成本, *chéngběn.*) Natural resources? (*zīyuán.*) To increase (in number)? (*zēngjiā.*) To push up (a level)? (*tígāo.*) Most likely (eight in ten)? (八成, *bāchéng.*) To save energy? (节能, *jiénéng.*) To attach importance to? (*zhòngshì.*) A way of doing things? (*fāngshì.*)

Chapter 386

Second-Hand

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about second-hand things, how something turned into something else, unused things, good value and the weather turning.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 386: I can talk about second-hand things, how something turned into something else, unused things, good value and the weather turning.*

386.1 二手 (èrshǒu) — second-hand

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to attach importance to, then the Mandarin for a way of doing things.

You'll want to know: 二手

二手 — *èrshǒu* — "second-hand".

> *wǒ mǎi le yí ge èrshǒu shǒujī yīnwèi hěn piányi* — I bought a second-hand phone because it was cheap.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

二手 (*èrshǒu*) is built from 二 'two' and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyijH* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): through a second pair of hands.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: èrshǒu*
- *Say it: èrshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǎi le yí ge èrshǒu shǒujī yīnwèi hěn piányi* — I bought a second-hand phone because it was cheap.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to attach importance to, then the Mandarin for a way of doing things, then say *èrshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 二手 mean? ("Second-hand".) Say it once more.

386.2 变成 (biànchéng) — to turn into

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a way of doing things, then the Mandarin for second-hand.

You'll want to know: 变成

变成 — *biànchéng* — "to turn into".

> 那家饭店变成了书店 *nà jiā fàndiàn biànchéng le shūdiàn* — That restaurant has turned into a bookshop.

The new character, in pieces: 变 — eight strokes in two pieces: on top a dot and a bar over four short strokes; at the foot 又, two strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

变成 (*biànchéng*) is built from 变 'to change' and 成 'to complete', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjenH* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to transform'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: biànchéng*
- *Say it: biànchéng*, once more
- *Say it: nà jiā fàndiàn biànchéng le shūdiàn* — That restaurant has turned into a bookshop.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a way of doing things, then the Mandarin for second-hand, then say *biànchéng* again

Before you move on

What does 变成 mean? ("To turn into".) Say it once more.

386.3 变 — a dot and a bar over four short strokes, then 又

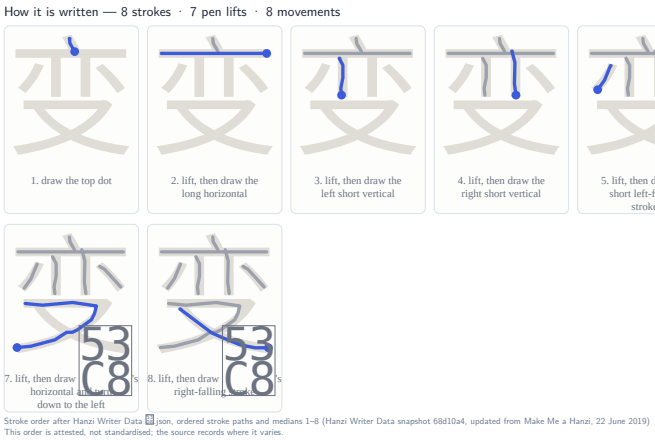
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *biànchéng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  文 又

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wén*, *yòu*

Script — a dot and a bar over four short strokes, then 又



How 变 *is written, stroke by stroke*

变

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top piece, six strokes. A dot, then a long bar under it, as at the top of 文. Two short verticals under the bar, the left one first. Then a short stroke falling to the left beside the left vertical, and a dot falling to the right beside the right one.

The bottom piece, 又, two strokes, as you wrote it: a bar that turns and falls to the lower left, then a long stroke falling to the right across it.

6 + 2 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 变, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 变? (**Eight.**) How does it start? (**A dot and a bar, as in 文.**) What is the bottom piece? (**又, two strokes.**) Source: Hanzi Writer Data 变, pinned stroke paths and medians.

386.4 xiánzhì — unused; lying idle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for second-hand, then the Mandarin for to turn into.

You'll want to know: xiánzhì

xiánzhì — "unused; lying idle".

jiā lǐ xiánzhì de dōngxi kěyǐ sòng gěi péngyou — Things you don't use at home can go to friends.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiánzhì is built from *xián* 'idle' and *zhì* 'to put', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hean* and *triH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'leisure' and the second 'to set down'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiánzhì*
- *Say it: xiánzhì*, once more
- *Say it: jiā lǐ xiánzhì de dōngxi kěyǐ sòng gěi péngyou* — Things you don't use at home can go to friends.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for second-hand, then the Mandarin for to turn into, then say *xiánzhì* again

Before you move on

What does xiánzhì mean? ("Unused; lying idle".) Say it once more.

386.5 huásuàn — good value; worth it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn into, then the Mandarin for sitting unused at home.

You'll want to know: huásuàn

huásuàn — "good value; worth it".

> *wǒ juéde èrshǒu chē bǐ xīn chē huásuàn* — I think a second-hand car is better value than a new one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huásuàn is built from *huá* and *suàn* 'to count'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *swanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the number of things'; the dictionary glosses the first 'to row a boat', and how it came into this word is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: huásuàn*
- *Say it: huásuàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde èrshǒu chē bǐ xīn chē huásuàn* — I think a second-hand car is better value than a new one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn into, then the Mandarin for sitting unused at home, then say *huásuàn* again

Before you move on

What does huásuàn mean? ("Good value; worth it".) Say it once more.

386.6 变天 (biàntiān) — to turn bad (of the weather)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sitting unused at home, then the Mandarin for good value for money.

You'll want to know: 变天

变天 — *biàntiān* — "to turn bad (of the weather)".

> 要变天了你最好早回家 *yào biàntiān le nǐ zuìhǎo zǎo huí jiā* — The weather's about to turn; you'd better get home early.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

变天 (*biàntiān*) is built from 变 'to change' and 天 'the sky', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjenH* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: biàntiān*
- *Say it: biàntiān*, once more
- *Say it: yào biàntiān le nǐ zuìhǎo zǎo huí jiā* — The weather's about to turn; you'd better get home early.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sitting unused at home, then the Mandarin for good value for money, then say *biàntiān* again

Before you move on

What does 变天 mean? ("To turn bad (of the weather)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 387

Money In, Money Out

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about income, savings, bills, shopping online and a budget.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 387: I can talk about income, savings, bills, shopping online and a budget.*

387.1 shōurù — income

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for good value for money, then the Mandarin for to turn bad (of the weather).

You'll want to know: shōurù

shōurù — "income".

> *yīnwèi tā de shōurù bù gāo suǒyǐ tā měitiān zài jiā zuòfàn* — His income isn't high, so he cooks at home every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōurù is built from *shōu* 'to gather' and *rù* 'to go in', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw* and *nyip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to take in'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōurù*
- *Say it: shōurù*, once more
- *Say it: yīnwèi tā de shōurù bù gāo suǒyǐ tā měitiān zài jiā zuòfàn* — His income isn't high, so he cooks at home every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for good value for money, then the Mandarin for to turn bad (of the weather), then say *shōurù* again

Before you move on

What does shōurù mean? ("Income".) Say it once more.

387.2 cúnkuǎn — savings (in the bank)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn bad (of the weather), then the Mandarin for income.

You'll want to know: cúnkuǎn

cúnkuǎn — "savings (in the bank)".

wǒ yǒu yìdiǎnr cúnkuǎn — I've got a little money saved.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cúnkuǎn is built from *cún* 'to keep' and *kuǎn* 'a sum', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzwon* and *khwanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be present' and the second 'sincere'. The sense 'a sum of money' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: cúnkuǎn*
- *Say it: cúnkuǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǒu yìdiǎnr cúnkuǎn* — I've got a little money saved.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn bad (of the weather), then the Mandarin for income, then say *cúnkuǎn* again

Before you move on

What does cúnkuǎn mean? ("Savings (in the bank)".) Say it once more.

387.3 zhàngdān — bill (to pay)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for income, then the Mandarin for savings (in the bank).

You'll want to know: zhàngdān

zhàngdān — "bill (to pay)".

zhège yuè de zhàngdān wǒ hái méi fù — I haven't paid this month's bills yet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhàngdān is built from *zhàng* 'an account' and *dān* 'a single sheet'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *tan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'single'; the dictionary has no entry for the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhàngdān*
- *Say it: zhàngdān*, once more
- *Say it: zhège yuè de zhàngdān wǒ hái méi fù* — I haven't paid this month's bills yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for income, then the Mandarin for savings (in the bank), then say *zhàngdān* again

Before you move on

What does zhàngdān mean? ("Bill (to pay)".) Say it once more.

387.4 wǎnggòu — to shop online

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for savings (in the bank), then the Mandarin for a bill (to pay).

You'll want to know: wǎnggòu

wǎnggòu — "to shop online".

wǒ juéde wǎnggòu bǐ qù shāngdiàn piányi — I think shopping online is cheaper than going to the shops.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǎnggòu is built from *wǎng* 'a net' and *gòu* 'to buy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjangX* and *kuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to buy back'. The word is a modern short form.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǎnggòu*
- *Say it: wǎnggòu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde wǎnggòu bǐ qù shāngdiàn piányi* — I think shopping online is cheaper than going to the shops.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for savings (in the bank), then the Mandarin for a bill (to pay), then say *wǎnggòu* again

Before you move on

What does wǎnggòu mean? ("To shop online".) Say it once more.

387.5 yùsuàn — budget

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bill (to pay), then the Mandarin for to shop online.

You'll want to know: yùsuàn

yùsuàn — "budget".

wǒmen de yùsuàn bú gòu suǒyǐ zuìhǎo mǎi èrshǒu de — Our budget isn't enough, so we'd better buy second-hand.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùsuàn is built from *yù* 'beforehand' and *suàn* 'to count', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yoH* and *swanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, among other senses, 'before'.

What you've built

One more word for giving reasons.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùsuàn*
- *Say it: yùsuàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de yùsuàn bú gòu suǒyǐ zuìhǎo mǎi èrshǒu de* — Our budget isn't enough, so we'd better buy second-hand.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bill (to pay), then the Mandarin for to shop online, then say *yùsuàn* again

Before you move on

What does yùsuàn mean? ("Budget".) Say it once more.

Chapter 388

Making a Date

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about finding time, a date, missing an appointment, telling people early and time zones.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 388: I can talk about finding time, a date, missing an appointment, telling people early and time zones.*

388.1 chōukòng — to find time (for something)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shop online, then the Mandarin for a budget.

You'll want to know: chōukòng

chōukòng — "to find time (for something)".

> *yàoshi nǐ néng chōukòng lái kàn wǒ wǒ huì hěn gāoxìng* — If you can find time to come and see me, I'll be really pleased.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chōukòng is built from *chōu* 'to pull out' and *kòng* 'a gap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trhjuw* and *khuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to draw out' and the second 'a gap'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chōukòng*
- *Say it: chōukòng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ néng chōukòng lái kàn wǒ wǒ huì hěn gāoxìng* — If you can find time to come and see me, I'll be really pleased.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shop online, then the Mandarin for a budget, then say *chōukòng* again

Before you move on

What does chōukòng mean? ("To find time (for something)".) Say it once more.

388.2 约会 (yuēhuì) — a romantic date; an appointment (to meet)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a budget, then the Mandarin for to find time (for something).

You'll want to know: 约会

约会 — *yuēhuì* — "a romantic date; an appointment (to meet)".

今天晚上我有一个约会 *jīntiān wǎnshang wǒ yǒu yí ge yuēhuì* — I've got a date this evening.

The new character, in pieces: 约 — six strokes in two pieces: the silk piece on the left of 给, three strokes; on the right a short fall, a bar that turns down into a hook, and a dot inside. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

约会 (*yuēhuì*) is built from 约 'to bind' and 会 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jak* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tie up' and the second 'to come together': a meeting agreed on beforehand.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuēhuì*
- *Say it: yuēhuì*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǎnshang wǒ yǒu yí ge yuēhuì* — I've got a date this evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a budget, then the Mandarin for to find time (for something), then say *yuēhuì* again

Before you move on

What does 约会 mean? ("A romantic date; an appointment (to meet)".) Say it once more.

388.3 约 — the silk piece of 给, then a hook around a dot

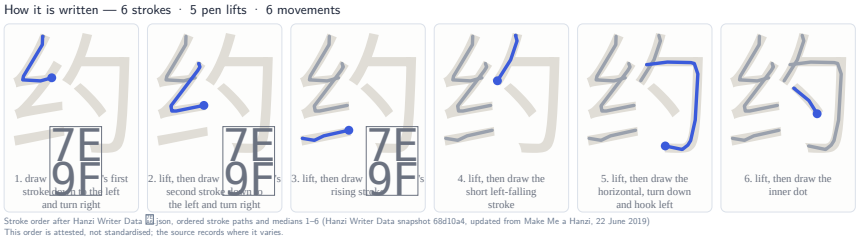
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yuēhuì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  给 会

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *gěi*, *huì*

Script — the silk piece of 给, then a hook around a dot



How 约 is written, stroke by stroke

约

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, the silk piece, three strokes, as on the left of 给: two strokes that each fall to the left and turn to the right, one under the other, then a short stroke rising to the right.

The right piece, three strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A bar that runs right and turns down into a long hook. Then a dot inside.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 约, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 约? (**Six.**) Where have you made the left piece before? (**On the left of 给.**) What comes last? (**The dot inside the hook.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 约, pinned stroke paths and medians.

388.4 shīyuē — to miss an appointment

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to find time (for something), then the Mandarin for a romantic date.

You'll want to know: shīyuē

shīyuē — "to miss an appointment".

> *rúguǒ nǐ shīyuē tā huì hěn shēngqì* — If you don't turn up, he'll be angry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīyuē is built from *shī* 'to lose' and 约 'an agreement', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *'jak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to let slip'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīyuē*
- *Say it: shīyuē*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ shīyuē tā huì hěn shēngqì* — If you don't turn up, he'll be angry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to find time (for something), then the Mandarin for a romantic date, then say *shīyuē* again

Before you move on

What does shīyuē mean? ("To miss an appointment".) Say it once more.

388.5 tíqián — to do ahead of time; to bring forward (a date)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a romantic date, then the Mandarin for to miss an appointment.

You'll want to know: tíqián

tíqián — "to do ahead of time; to bring forward (a date)".

> *yàoshi nǐ bù néng lái zuìhǎo tíqián gàosu wǒ* — If you can't come, you'd better tell me in good time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tíqián is built from *tí* 'to carry by the handle' and 前 'before', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dej* and *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'first': lifting a time forward.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíqián*
- *Say it: tíqián*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ bù néng lái zuìhǎo tíqián gàosu wǒ* — If you can't come, you'd better tell me in good time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a romantic date, then the Mandarin for to miss an appointment, then say *tíqián* again

Before you move on

What does tíqián mean? ("To do ahead of time; to bring forward (a date)".) Say it once more.

388.6 时区 (shíqū) — time zone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to miss an appointment, then the Mandarin for to do ahead of time.

You'll want to know: 时区

时区 — *shíqū* — "time zone".

> 我们不在一个时区所以要先约好时间 *wǒmen bú zài yí ge shíqū suǒyǐ yào xiān yuē hǎo shíjiān* — We're not in the same time zone, so we need to fix a time first.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

时区 (*shíqū*) is built from 时 'time' and 区 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyi* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'an hour of the day'. The word is modern.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: shíqū*
- *Say it: shíqū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen bú zài yí ge shíqū suǒyǐ yào xiān yuē hǎo shíjiān* — We're not in the same time zone, so we need to fix a time first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to miss an appointment, then the Mandarin for to do ahead of time, then say *shíqū* again

Before you move on

What does 时区 mean? ("Time zone".) Say it once more.

Chapter 389

In Case

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about spare things, using less, risks, being ready for anything and payments falling due.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 389: I can talk about spare things, using less, risks, being ready for anything and payments falling due.*

389.1 bèiyòng — spare (kept for when needed)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to do ahead of time, then the Mandarin for a time zone.

You'll want to know: bèiyòng

bèiyòng — "spare (kept for when needed)".

> *wànyī yàoshi diū le wǒmen hái yǒu bèiyòng de* — If the keys get lost, we've still got a spare.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bèiyòng is built from *bèi* 'to provide against' and 用 'to use', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bijH* and *youngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'complete' and 'to guard against'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: bèiyòng*
- *Say it: bèiyòng*, once more
- *Say it: wànyī yàoshi diū le wǒmen hái yǒu bèiyòng de* — If the keys get lost, we've still got a spare.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to do ahead of time, then the Mandarin for a time zone, then say *bèiyòng* again

Before you move on

What does bèiyòng mean? ("Spare (kept for when needed)".) Say it once more.

389.2 节约 (jiéyuē) — to economise; to use sparingly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a time zone, then the Mandarin for spare (kept for when needed).

You'll want to know: 节约

节约 — *jiéyuē* — "to economise; to use sparingly".

rúguǒ dàjiā dōu jiéyuē yòng shuǐ jiù néng shěngqián — If everyone uses water sparingly, we can all save money.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

节约 (*jiéyuē*) is built from 节 'to restrain' and 约 'sparing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tset* and *'jak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold back' and the second 'thrifty'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiéyuē*
- *Say it: jiéyuē*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ dàjiā dōu jiéyuē yòng shuǐ jiù néng shěngqián* — If everyone uses water sparingly, we can all save money.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a time zone, then the Mandarin for spare (kept for when needed), then say *jiéyuē* again

Before you move on

What does 节约 mean? ("To economise; to use sparingly".) Say it once more.

389.3 fēngxiǎn — risk

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for spare (kept for when needed), then the Mandarin for to economise.

You'll want to know: fēngxiǎn

fēngxiǎn — "risk".

yàoshi fēngxiǎn tài dà wǒmen jiù bú zuò le — If the risk is too great, we won't do it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēngxiǎn is built from 风 'the wind' and *xiǎn* 'dangerous', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwng* and *xjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'perilous' and 'hard to pass'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēngxiǎn*
- *Say it: fēngxiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi fēngxiǎn tài dà wǒmen jiù bú zuò le* — If the risk is too great, we won't do it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for spare (kept for when needed), then the Mandarin for to economise, then say *fēngxiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does fēngxiǎn mean? ("Risk".) Say it once more.

389.4 yǐfáng — so as to guard against; as a precaution

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to economise, then the Mandarin for a risk.

You'll want to know: yǐfáng

yǐfáng — "so as to guard against; as a precaution".

dài yìdiǎnr qián yǐfáng wànyī — Take a bit of money with you, in case.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǐfáng is built from 以 'by means of' and *fáng* 'to guard against', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yiX* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to use' and the second 'to defend' and 'a dyke'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǐfáng*
- *Say it: yǐfáng*, once more
- *Say it: dài yìdiǎnr qián yǐfáng wànyī* — Take a bit of money with you, in case.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to economise, then the Mandarin for a risk, then say *yǐfáng* again

Before you move on

What does yǐfáng mean? ("So as to guard against; as a precaution".) Say it once more.

389.5 到期 (dàoqī) — to fall due; to run out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a risk, then the Mandarin for as a precaution.

You'll want to know: 到期

到期 — *dàoqī* — "to fall due; to run out".

fángzū xià ge yuè jiù dàoqī le — The rent falls due next month.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

到期 (*dàoqī*) is built from 到 'to arrive' and 期 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tawH* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a limit' and 'an appointed meeting'. Middle Chinese *gi* would regularly give a rising tone, qí; the level tone of qī is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàoqī*
- *Say it: dàoqī*, once more
- *Say it: fángzū xià ge yuè jiù dàoqī le* — The rent falls due next month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a risk, then the Mandarin for as a precaution, then say *dàoqī* again

Before you move on

What does 到期 mean? ("To fall due; to run out".) Say it once more.

Chapter 390

As We Agreed

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about being sure, agreeing on a time, doing things regularly, keeping to a date and giving a rough time.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 390: I can talk about being sure, agreeing on a time, doing things regularly, keeping to a date and giving a rough time.*

390.1 quèdìng — to be certain; to settle on

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as a precaution, then the Mandarin for to fall due.

You'll want to know: quèdìng

quèdìng — "to be certain; to settle on".

> *wǒ hái bú quèdìng míngtiān néng bu néng qù* — I'm not sure yet whether I can go tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

quèdìng is built from *què* 'firm' and *dìng* 'settled', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaewk* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'steadfast' and the second 'calm'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: quèdìng*
- *Say it: quèdìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hái bú quèdìng míngtiān néng bu néng qù* — I'm not sure yet whether I can go tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as a precaution, then the Mandarin for to fall due, then say *quèdìng* again

Before you move on

What does quèdìng mean? ("To be certain; to settle on".) Say it once more.

390.2 约定 (yuēdìng) — to agree on a time; to fix (a time or place) together

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fall due, then the Mandarin for to be certain.

You'll want to know: 约定

约定 — *yuēdìng* — "to agree on a time; to fix (a time or place) together".

> 我们约定明天早上八点见面 *wǒmen yuēdìng míngtiān zǎoshang bā diǎn jiànmiàn* — We agreed to meet at eight tomorrow morning.

The new character, in pieces: 定 — eight strokes in two pieces: the roof of 安 on top, and under it the five strokes at the foot of 是. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

约定 (*yuēdìng*) is built from 约 'to bind' and 定 'settled', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jak* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'calm'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuēdìng*
- *Say it: yuēdìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yuēdìng míngtiān zǎoshang bā diǎn jiànmiàn* — We agreed to meet at eight tomorrow morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fall due, then the Mandarin for to be certain, then say *yuēdìng* again

Before you move on

What does 约定 mean? ("To agree on a time; to fix (a time or place) together".) Say it once more.

390.3 定 — the roof of 安 over the foot of 是

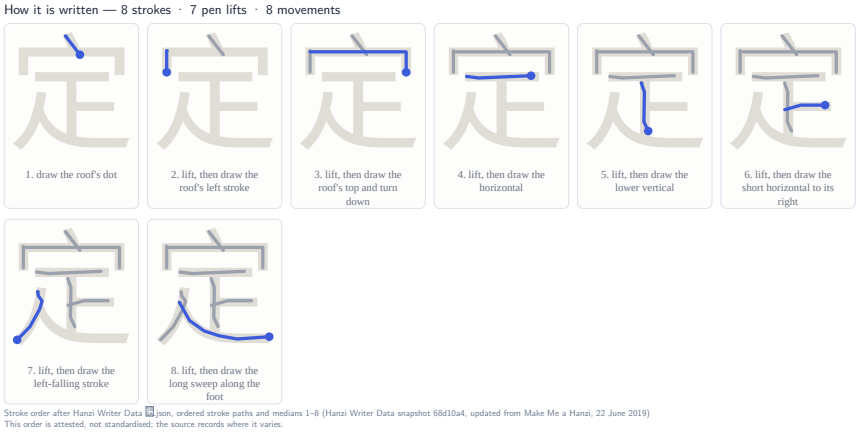
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yuēdìng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  安 是

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *ān*, *shì*

Script — the roof of 安 over the foot of 是



How 定 *is written, stroke by stroke*

定

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The roof, three strokes, as on top of 安: a dot, a short stroke down on the left, and a bar that turns down and hooks.

Under it, five strokes, the foot of 是. A bar. A short vertical down from its middle. A short bar to the right of the vertical. Then a stroke falling to the left, and a long stroke falling to the right that sweeps along the foot.

3 + 5 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 定, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 定? (**Eight.**) What is on top? (**The roof of 安.**) Where have you made the bottom piece before? (**At the foot of 是.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 定, pinned stroke paths and medians.

390.4 定期 (dìngqī) — at regular intervals; periodically

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be certain, then the Mandarin for to agree on a time.

You'll want to know: 定期

定期 — *dìngqī* — "at regular intervals; periodically".

你最好定期去看医生 *nǐ zuìhǎo dìngqī qù kàn yīshēng* — You'd better see a doctor regularly.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

定期 (*dìngqī*) is built from 定 'settled' and 期 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dengH* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a limit'. The level tone of qī is irregular, as in 星期.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìngqī*
- *Say it: dìngqī*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuìhǎo dìngqī qù kàn yīshēng* — You'd better see a doctor regularly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be certain, then the Mandarin for to agree on a time, then say *dìngqī* again

Before you move on

What does **定期** mean? ("At regular intervals; periodically".) Say it once more.

390.5 如期 (rúqī) — as planned (on the agreed date)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to agree on a time, then the Mandarin for at regular intervals.

You'll want to know: 如期

如期 — *rúqī* — "as planned (on the agreed date)".

要是不下雨我们就如期去山里 *yàoshi bú xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù rúqī qù shān lǐ* — If it doesn't rain, we'll go to the hills as planned.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

如期 (*rúqī*) is built from **如** 'as' and **期** 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyo* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'like' and the second 'an appointed meeting'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: rúqī*
- *Say it: rúqī*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi bú xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù rúqī qù shān lǐ* — If it doesn't rain, we'll go to the hills as planned.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to agree on a time, then the Mandarin for at regular intervals, then say *rúqī* again

Before you move on

What does 如期 mean? ("As planned (on the agreed date)".) Say it once more.

390.6 大约 (dàyuē) — approximately; roughly (a time or number)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at regular intervals, then the Mandarin for on the agreed date.

You'll want to know: 大约

大约 — *dàyuē* — "approximately; roughly (a time or number)".

yàoshi bù dǔchē wǒ dàyuē bā diǎn dào — If there's no traffic, I'll be there at about eight.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大约 (*dàyuē*) is built from 大 'big' and 约 'to bind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dajH* and *'jak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to tie up' and 'sparing'. How the pair came to mean 'roughly' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàyuē*
- *Say it: dàyuē*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi bù dǔchē wǒ dàyuē bā diǎn dào* — If there's no traffic, I'll be there at about eight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at regular intervals, then the Mandarin for on the agreed date, then say *dàyuē* again

Before you move on

What does 大约 mean? ("Approximately; roughly (a time or number)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 391

When Plans Change

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a day's schedule, things at the last minute, still having time, catching a train and what we will do when the time comes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 391: I can talk about a day's schedule, things at the last minute, still having time, catching a train and what we will do when the time comes.*

391.1 rìchéng — a day's schedule

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for on the agreed date, then the Mandarin for approximately.

You'll want to know: rìchéng

rìchéng — "a day's schedule".

> *míngtiān de rìchéng hěn mǎn* — Tomorrow's schedule is full.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rìchéng is built from 日 'a day' and *chéng* 'a stage of a journey', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyit* and *drjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a set term' and 'a limit'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: rìchéng*
- *Say it: rìchéng*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān de rìchéng hěn mǎn* — Tomorrow's schedule is full.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for on the agreed date, then the Mandarin for approximately, then say *rìchéng* again

Before you move on

What does rìchéng mean? ("A day's schedule".) Say it once more.

391.2 línshí — at the last minute; for the time being

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for approximately, then the Mandarin for a day's schedule.

You'll want to know: línshí

línshí — "at the last minute; for the time being".

wǒ línshí yǒushì bù néng qù le — Something's come up at the last minute and I can't go.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

línshí is built from *lín* 'to come close' and 时 'the time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lim* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be present at': when the moment is upon you.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: línshí*
- *Say it: línshí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ línshí yǒushì bù néng qù le* — Something's come up at the last minute and I can't go.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for approximately, then the Mandarin for a day's schedule, then say *línshí* again

Before you move on

What does línshí mean? ("At the last minute; for the time being".) Say it once more.

391.3 láidejí — to still have time (to do something)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a day's schedule, then the Mandarin for at the last minute.

You'll want to know: láidejí

láidejí — "to still have time (to do something)".

rúguǒ xiànzài zǒu hái láidejí — If we leave now, there's still time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

láidejí is built from 来 'to come', 得 'can' and *jí* 'to reach', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *loj*, *tok* and *gip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'to get to': you can still get there. It is the other side of láibují.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: láidejí*
- *Say it: láidejí*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ xiànzài zǒu hái láidejí* — If we leave now, there's still time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a day's schedule, then the Mandarin for at the last minute, then say *láidejí* again

Before you move on

What does láidejí mean? ("To still have time (to do something)".) Say it once more.

391.4 gǎnshàng — to catch in time; to make it onto a train

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at the last minute, then the Mandarin for to still have time.

You'll want to know: gǎnshàng

gǎnshàng — "to catch in time; to make it onto a train".

yàoshi wǒmen kuài yìdiǎnr jiù néng gǎnshàng huǒchē — If we're a bit quicker, we can catch the train.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎnshàng is built from *gǎn* 'to chase' and 上 'to go up'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to climb'; the dictionary has no entry for the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnshàng*
- *Say it: gǎnshàng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi wǒmen kuài yìdiǎnr jiù néng gǎnshàng huǒchē* — If we're a bit quicker, we can catch the train.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at the last minute, then the Mandarin for to still have time, then say *gǎnshàng* again

Before you move on

What does gǎnshàng mean? ("To catch in time; to make it onto a train".) Say it once more.

391.5 到时候 (dào shíhou) — when the time comes

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to still have time, then the Mandarin for to make it onto a train.

You'll want to know: 到时候

到时候 — *dào shíhou* — "when the time comes".

到时候我一定来 *dào shíhou wǒ yídìng lái* — When the time comes, I'll be there for sure.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

到时候 (*dào shíhou*) is built from 到 'to arrive' and 时候 'the time', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tawH*, *dzyi* and *huwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'to wait for'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dào shíhou*
- *Say it: dào shíhou*, once more
- *Say it: dào shíhou wǒ yídìng lái* — When the time comes, I'll be there for sure.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to still have time, then the Mandarin for to make it onto a train, then say *dào shíhou* again

Before you move on

What does 到时候 mean? ("When the time comes".) Say it once more.

391.6 Looking back: from Second-Hand to When Plans Change

Say the Mandarin for second-hand and to turn into.

Your turn

- *Say it:* second-hand, to turn into, sitting unused at home, good value for money, to turn bad (of the weather)
- *Say it:* income, savings (in the bank), a bill (to pay), to shop online, a budget
- *Say it:* to find time (for something), a romantic date, to miss an appointment, to do ahead of time, a time zone
- *Say it:* spare (kept for when needed), to economise, a risk, as a precaution, to fall due
- *Say it:* to be certain, to agree on a time, at regular intervals, on the agreed date, approximately

- *Say it:* a day's schedule, at the last minute, to still have time, to make it onto a train, when the time comes
- *Read it:* 变 约 定 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Second-hand? (二手, *èrshǒu.*) To turn into? (变成, *biànchéng.*) Sitting unused at home? (*xiánzhì.*) Good value for money? (*huásuàn.*) To turn bad (of the weather)? (变天, *biàntiān.*) Income? (*shōurù.*) Savings (in the bank)? (*cúnkuǎn.*) A bill (to pay)? (*zhàngdān.*) To shop online? (*wǎnggòu.*) A budget? (*yùsuàn.*) To find time (for something)? (*chōukòng.*) A romantic date? (约会, *yuēhuì.*) To miss an appointment? (*shīyuē.*) To do ahead of time? (*tíqián.*) A time zone? (时区, *shíqū.*) Spare (kept for when needed)? (*bèiyòng.*) To economise? (节约, *jiéyuē.*) A risk? (*fēngxiǎn.*) As a precaution? (*yǐfáng.*) To fall due? (到期, *dàoqī.*) To be certain? (*quèdìng.*) To agree on a time? (约定, *yuēdìng.*) At regular intervals? (定期, *dìngqī.*) On the agreed date? (如期, *rúqī.*) Approximately? (大约, *dàyuē.*) A day's schedule? (*rìchéng.*) At the last minute? (*línshí.*) To still have time? (*láidejí.*) To make it onto a train? (*gǎnshàng.*) When the time comes? (到时候, *dào shíhou.*)

Chapter 392

A Change of Plan

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about changing things, changing a date, changing plans, new names and someone changing their tune.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 392: I can talk about changing things, changing a date, changing plans, new names and someone changing their tune.*

392.1 改 (gǎi) — to alter; to amend

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make it onto a train, then the Mandarin for when the time comes.

You'll want to know: 改

改 — *gǎi* — "to alter; to amend".

> 时间改了我们下午三点见面 *shíjiān gǎi le wǒmen xiàwǔ sān diǎn jiànmiàn* — The time's changed: we're meeting at three in the afternoon.

The new character, in pieces: 改 — seven strokes in two pieces: on the left a bar that turns down, a short bar, and a vertical that bends right and flicks up; on the right the right piece of 做. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

改 (*gǎi*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *kojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to change'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎi*
- *Say it: gǎi*, once more
- *Say it: shíjiān gǎi le wǒmen xiàwǔ sān diǎn jiànmiàn* — The time's changed: we're meeting at three in the afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make it onto a train, then the Mandarin for when the time comes, then say *gǎi* again

Before you move on

What does 改 mean? ("To alter; to amend".) Say it once more.

392.2 改 — a bent piece, then the right piece of 做

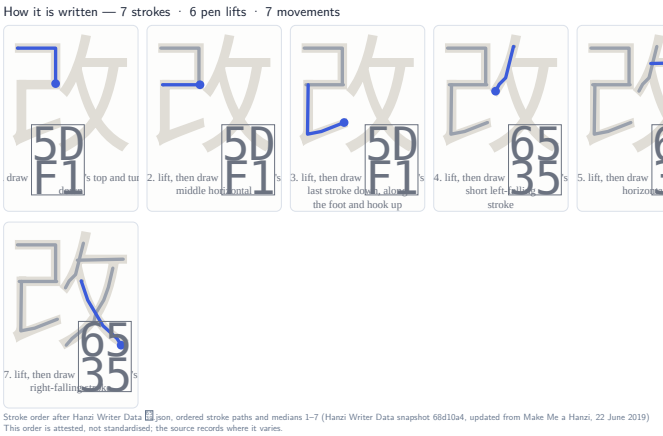
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gǎi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  做 变

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zuò*, *biàn*

Script — a bent piece, then the right piece of 做



How 改 *is written, stroke by stroke*

改

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, three strokes. A bar that turns down. A short bar under it. Then a vertical that comes down, bends right along the foot and flicks up.

The right piece, four strokes, the right piece of 做. A short stroke falling to the left. A bar from it to the right. A long stroke falling to the left. Then a long stroke falling to the right across it.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 改, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 改? (**Seven.**) Where have you made the right piece before? (**On the right of 做.**) How does the left piece end? (**A bend to the right and a flick up.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 改, pinned stroke paths and medians.

392.3 改期 (gǎiqī) — to change the date (of an event)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for when the time comes, then the Mandarin for to alter.

You'll want to know: 改期

改期 — *gǎiqī* — "to change the date (of an event)".

要是下雨晚会就改期 *yàoshi xiàyǔ wǎnhuì jiù gǎiqī* — If it rains, the party will be moved to another date.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

改期 (*gǎiqī*) is built from 改 'to alter' and 期 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'an appointed meeting'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎiqī*
- *Say it: gǎiqī*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi xiàyǔ wǎnhuì jiù gǎiqī* — If it rains, the party will be moved to another date.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for when the time comes, then the Mandarin for to alter, then say *gǎiqī* again

Before you move on

What does 改期 mean? ("To change the date (of an event)".) Say it once more.

392.4 改变 (gǎibiàn) — to make different (a plan or a habit)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to alter, then the Mandarin for to change the date.

You'll want to know: 改变

改变 — *gǎibiàn* — "to make different (a plan or a habit)".

rúguǒ tiānqì bù hǎo wǒmen jiù gǎibiàn jìhuà — If the weather's bad, we'll change our plans.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

改变 (*gǎibiàn*) is built from **改** 'to alter' and **变** 'to change', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *pjenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to change' and the second 'to transform'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎibiàn*
- *Say it: gǎibiàn*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ tiānqì bù hǎo wǒmen jiù gǎibiàn jìhuà* — If the weather's bad, we'll change our plans.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to alter, then the Mandarin for to change the date, then say *gǎibiàn* again

Before you move on

What does **改变** mean? ("To make different (a plan or a habit)".) Say it once more.

392.5 改名 (gǎimíng) — to change the name (of)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change the date, then the Mandarin for to make different.

You'll want to know: 改名

改名 — *gǎimíng* — "to change the name (of)".

那家饭店改名了 *nà jiā fàndiàn gǎimíng le* — That restaurant has changed its name.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

改名 (*gǎimíng*) is built from **改** 'to alter' and **名** 'a name', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *mjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎimíng*
- *Say it: gǎimíng*, once more
- *Say it: nà jiā fàndiàn gǎimíng le* — That restaurant has changed its name.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change the date, then the Mandarin for to make different, then say *gǎimíng* again

Before you move on

What does **改名** mean? ("To change the name (of)".) Say it once more.

392.6 改口 (gǎikǒu) — to change one's tune; to take back what one said

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make different, then the Mandarin for to change the name (of).

You'll want to know: 改口

改口 — *gǎikǒu* — "to change one's tune; to take back what one said".

tā zuótiān shuō bú qù jīntiān yòu gǎikǒu le — Yesterday he said he wasn't going; today he's changed his tune.

Two third tones meet in this word: gǎi is said with a rising tone before kǒu, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

改口 (*gǎikǒu*) is built from 改 'to alter' and 口 'the mouth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'what a person speaks and eats with': altering what comes out of the mouth.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎikǒu*
- *Say it: gǎikǒu*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuótiān shuō bú qù jīntiān yòu gǎikǒu le* — Yesterday he said he wasn't going; today he's changed his tune.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make different, then the Mandarin for to change the name (of), then say *gǎikǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 改口 mean? ("To change one's tune; to take back what one said".) Say it once more.

Chapter 393

Be Sure To

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about telling someone to remember, being sure to, what money can't do, any time and things going smoothly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 393: I can talk about telling someone to remember, being sure to, what money can't do, any time and things going smoothly.*

393.1 zhǔfu — to exhort; to tell (someone) to be sure to do something

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change the name (of), then the Mandarin for to change one's tune.

You'll want to know: zhǔfu

zhǔfu — "to exhort; to tell (someone) to be sure to do something".

> *māma zhǔfu wǒ wǎnshang zǎo huí jiā* — Mum told me to be sure to come home early tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔfu is built from *zhǔ* 'to entrust' and *fu*. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to entrust to'; the dictionary has no entry for the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔfu*
- *Say it: zhǔfu*, once more
- *Say it: māma zhǔfu wǒ wǎnshang zǎo huí jiā* — Mum told me to be sure to come home early tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change the name (of), then the Mandarin for to change one's tune, then say *zhǔfu* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔfu mean? ("To exhort; to tell (someone) to be sure to do something".) Say it once more.

393.2 千万 (qiānwàn) — be sure to (urging); whatever you do

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change one's tune, then the Mandarin for to exhort (someone).

You'll want to know: 千万

千万 — *qiānwàn* — "be sure to (urging); whatever you do".

> 你一个人在外边千万要保重 *nǐ yí ge rén zài wàibian qiānwàn yào bǎozhòng* — Out there on your own, be sure to look after yourself.

The new character, in pieces: 万 — three strokes: a long bar, a stroke that runs right and turns down with a hook, and a long stroke falling to the left. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

千万 (*qiānwàn*) is built from 千 'a thousand' and 万 'ten thousand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshen* and *mjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'ten hundreds'; for the second it names a dance and an insect, and the number is not given there. A thousand times, ten thousand times over: the urging sense is usually explained that way.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiānwàn*
- *Say it: qiānwàn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yí ge rén zài wàibian qiānwàn yào bǎozhòng* — Out there on your own, be sure to look after yourself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change one's tune, then the Mandarin for to exhort (someone), then say *qiānwàn* again

Before you move on

What does 千万 mean? ("Be sure to (urging); whatever you do".) Say it once more.

393.3 万 — a bar, a turning hook, a long fall

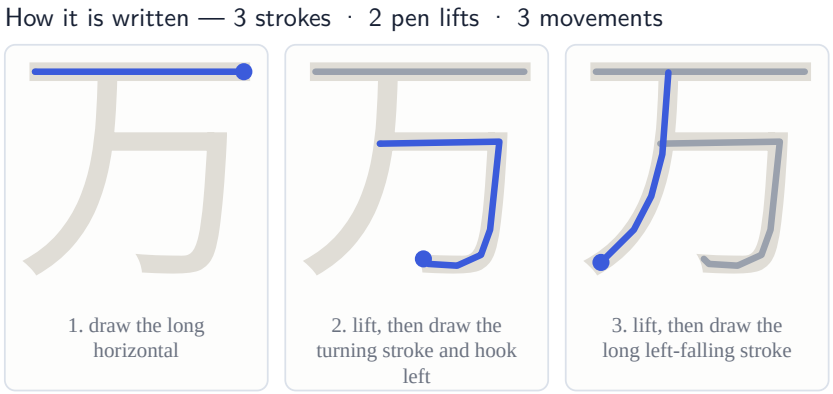
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qiānwàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  千 为

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qiān*, *wéi*

Script — a bar, a turning hook, a long fall



How 万 is written, stroke by stroke

万

Three strokes, top to bottom.

A long bar across the top.

A turning hook: from under the middle of the bar, a stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks to the left, as in 为 and 月.

A long stroke falling to the left, from the bar down to the lower left.

One, two, three.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 万, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 万? (**Three.**) Which stroke has the hook? (**The second, the turning hook.**) Which comes last? (**The long fall to the left.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 万, pinned stroke paths and medians.

393.4 万能 (wànnéng) — able to do everything; all-purpose

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to exhort (someone), then the Mandarin for be sure to (urging).

You'll want to know: 万能

万能 — *wànnéng* — "able to do everything; all-purpose".

méiyǒu wànnéng de bànfǎ — There's no way that works for everything.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

万能 (*wànnéng*) is built from 万 'ten thousand' and 能 'able', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonH* and *nong* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'skilled': able in ten thousand things.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: wànnéng*
- *Say it: wànnéng*, once more
- *Say it: méiyǒu wànnéng de bànfǎ* — There's no way that works for everything.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to exhort (someone), then the Mandarin for be sure to (urging), then say *wànnéng* again

Before you move on

What does 万能 mean? ("Able to do everything; all-purpose".) Say it once more.

393.5 suíshí — at any time; whenever needed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for be sure to (urging), then the Mandarin for all-purpose.

You'll want to know: suíshí

suíshí — "at any time; whenever needed".

yàoshi yǒushì nǐ suíshí lái zhǎo wǒ — If anything comes up, come and find me any time.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suíshí is built from *suí* 'to follow' and 时 'the time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zjwe* and *dzyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go along with': whatever the time.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: suíshí*
- *Say it: suíshí*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi yǒushì nǐ suíshí lái zhǎo wǒ* — If anything comes up, come and find me any time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for be sure to (urging), then the Mandarin for all-purpose, then say *suíshí* again

Before you move on

What does suíshí mean? ("At any time; whenever needed".) Say it once more.

393.6 shùnlì — smooth; without a hitch

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all-purpose, then the Mandarin for at any time at all.

You'll want to know: shùnlì

shùnlì — "smooth; without a hitch".

rúguǒ shùnlì dehuà wǒmen wǔ diǎn jiù dào — If all goes well, we'll be there by five.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shùnlì is built from *shùn* 'to go along with' and *lì* 'favourable', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zywinH* and *lijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to follow' and the second 'auspicious'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: shùnlì*
- *Say it: shùnlì*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ shùnlì dehuà wǒmen wǔ diǎn jiù dào* — If all goes well, we'll be there by five.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all-purpose, then the Mandarin for at any time at all, then say *shùnlì* again

Before you move on

What does shùnlì mean? (“Smooth; without a hitch”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 394

Success or Failure

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about succeeding, failing, taking a risk, effort going to waste and things staying the same.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 394: I can talk about succeeding, failing, taking a risk, effort going to waste and things staying the same.*

394.1 chénggōng — to succeed

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at any time at all, then the Mandarin for going smoothly.

You'll want to know: chénggōng

chénggōng — "to succeed".

> *rúguǒ nǐ nǔlì jiù huì chénggōng* — If you work hard, you'll succeed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chénggōng is built from 成 'to complete' and *gōng* 'merit', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'an achievement'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chénggōng*
- *Say it: chénggōng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ nǔlì jiù huì chénggōng* — If you work hard, you'll succeed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at any time at all, then the Mandarin for going smoothly, then say *chénggōng* again

Before you move on

What does chénggōng mean? ("To succeed".) Say it once more.

394.2 shībài — to fail

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for going smoothly, then the Mandarin for to succeed.

You'll want to know: shībài

shībài — "to fail".

shībài le yě méi guānxi wǒmen zài lái — It doesn't matter if we fail; we'll try again.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shībài is built from *shī* 'to lose' and *bài* 'to fall apart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *baejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to break of itself'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: shībài*
- *Say it: shībài*, once more
- *Say it: shībài le yě méi guānxi wǒmen zài lái* — It doesn't matter if we fail; we'll try again.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for going smoothly, then the Mandarin for to succeed, then say *shībài* again

Before you move on

What does shībài mean? ("To fail".) Say it once more.

394.3 màoxiǎn — to take a risk

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to succeed, then the Mandarin for to fail.

You'll want to know: màoxiǎn

màoxiǎn — "to take a risk".

> *rúguǒ nǐ bù xiǎng màoxiǎn jiù bié qù* — If you don't want to take the risk, don't go.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

màoxiǎn is built from *mào* 'to wade into' and *xiǎn* 'danger', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mawH* and *xjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to cover' and 'to wade' and the second 'perilous'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: màoxiǎn*
- *Say it: màoxiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ bù xiǎng màoxiǎn jiù bié qù* — If you don't want to take the risk, don't go.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to succeed, then the Mandarin for to fail, then say *màoxiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does màoxiǎn mean? ("To take a risk".) Say it once more.

394.4 báifèi — to be wasted (of effort)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fail, then the Mandarin for to take a risk.

You'll want to know: báifèi

báifèi — "to be wasted (of effort)".

yàoshi nǐ xiànzài bú zuò yǐqián de nǔlì jiù báifèi le — If you don't do it now, all your work so far will be wasted.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

báifèi is built from 白 'white, blank' and *fèi* 'to use up', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *baek* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the colour of the west'. 白 for 'in vain' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: báifèi*
- *Say it: báifèi*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ xiànzài bú zuò yǐqián de nǔlì jiù báifèi le* — If you don't do it now, all your work so far will be wasted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fail, then the Mandarin for to take a risk, then say *báifèi* again

Before you move on

What does báifèi mean? ("To be wasted (of effort)".) Say it once more.

394.5 不变 (búbiàn) — unchanged; staying the same

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take a risk, then the Mandarin for to be wasted (of effort).

You'll want to know: 不变

不变 — *búbiàn* — "unchanged; staying the same".

时间不变地点改了 *shíjiān búbiàn dìdiǎn gǎi le* — The time stays the same; the place has changed.

Tone: 不 is said bú here, rising, because biàn after it is a falling tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不变 (*búbiàn*) is built from 不 'not' and 变 'to change', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *pjenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: búbiàn*
- *Say it: búbiàn*, once more
- *Say it: shíjiān búbiàn dìdiǎn gǎi le* — The time stays the same; the place has changed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take a risk, then the Mandarin for to be wasted (of effort), then say *búbiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 不变 mean? ("Unchanged; staying the same".) Say it once more.

Chapter 395

Getting Results

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about dreams coming true, achieving something, results, finishing a job and a condition.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 395: I can talk about dreams coming true, achieving something, results, finishing a job and a condition.*

395.1 shíxiàn — to come true; to make real

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be wasted (of effort), then the Mandarin for staying the same.

You'll want to know: shíxiàn

shíxiàn — "to come true; to make real".

> *yàoshi yǒu qián wǒ de mèngxiǎng jiù néng shíxiàn* — If I had the money, my dream could come true.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shíxiàn is built from *shí* 'real' and 现 'to appear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zyit* and *henH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'full' and 'true' and the second 'to show'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: shíxiàn*
- *Say it: shíxiàn*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi yǒu qián wǒ de mèngxiǎng jiù néng shíxiàn* — If I had the money, my dream could come true.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be wasted (of effort), then the Mandarin for staying the same, then say *shíxiàn* again

Before you move on

What does shíxiàn mean? ("To come true; to make real".) Say it once more.

395.2 取得 (qǔdé) — to achieve; to obtain (through effort)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for staying the same, then the Mandarin for to come true.

You'll want to know: 取得

取得 — *qǔdé* — "to achieve; to obtain (through effort)".

tā qǔdé le hěn hǎo de chéngjì — She got very good marks.

The new character, in pieces: 取 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left the ear piece, six strokes; on the right 又, as at the foot of 变. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

取得 (*qǔdé*) is built from 取 'to take' and 得 'to get', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjuX* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to gather in' and 'to receive'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǔdé*
- *Say it: qǔdé*, once more
- *Say it: tā qǔdé le hěn hǎo de chéngjì* — She got very good marks.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for staying the same, then the Mandarin for to come true, then say *qǔdé* again

Before you move on

What does 取得 mean? ("To achieve; to obtain (through effort)".) Say it once more.

395.3 取 — the ear piece, then 又

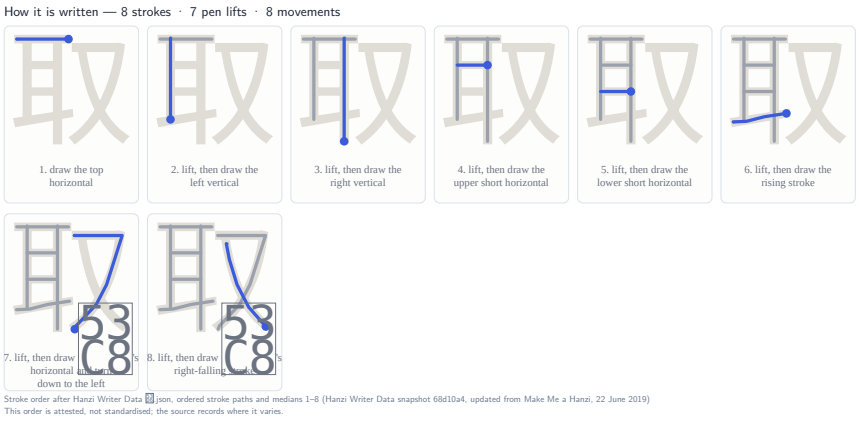
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qǔdé* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  变 又

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *biàn*, *yòu*

Script — the ear piece, then 又



How 取 *is written, stroke by stroke*

取

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, the ear piece, six strokes. A bar across the top. A short vertical down on the left. A long vertical down on the right, past the foot. Two short bars between them. Then a stroke rising to the right at the foot.

The right piece, 又, two strokes, as at the foot of 变: a bar that turns and falls to the lower left, then a long stroke falling to the right across it.

6 + 2 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 取, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 取? (**Eight.**) Which vertical is longer? (**The right one, past the foot.**) What is the right piece? (**又, as at the foot of 变.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 取, pinned stroke paths and medians.

395.4 成果 (chéngguǒ) — fruits of work; achievements

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come true, then the Mandarin for to obtain (through effort).

You'll want to know: 成果

成果 — *chéngguǒ* — "fruits of work; achievements".

我们今年取得了很好的成果 *wǒmen jīnnián qǔdé le hěn hǎo de chéngguǒ* — We got good results this year.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成果 (*chéngguǒ*) is built from 成 'to complete' and 果 'fruit', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the fruit of a tree' and 'resolute'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngguǒ*
- *Say it: chéngguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jīnnián qǔdé le hěn hǎo de chéngguǒ* — We got good results this year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come true, then the Mandarin for to obtain (through effort), then say *chéngguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does 成果 mean? ("Fruits of work; achievements".) Say it once more.

395.5 wánchéng — to complete; to get (a job) done

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to obtain (through effort), then the Mandarin for fruits of work.

You'll want to know: wánchéng

wánchéng — "to complete; to get (a job) done".

rúguǒ jīntiān néng wánchéng míngtiān jiù kěyǐ xiūxi — If we can finish today, we can rest tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wánchéng is built from *wán* 'whole' and 成 'to complete', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwan* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'complete'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: wánchéng*
- *Say it: wánchéng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ jīntiān néng wánchéng míngtiān jiù kěyǐ xiūxi* — If we can finish today, we can rest tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to obtain (through effort), then the Mandarin for fruits of work, then say *wánchéng* again

Before you move on

What does wánchéng mean? (“To complete; to get (a job) done”.) Say it once more.

395.6 tiáojiàn — condition (that must be met)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fruits of work, then the Mandarin for to get (a job) done.

You’ll want to know: tiáojiàn

tiáojiàn — “condition (that must be met)”.

wǒ kěyǐ qù kěshì yǒu yí ge tiáojiàn — I can go, but there’s one condition.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiáojiàn is built from *tiáo* ’a twig’ and *jiàn* ’a portion’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dew* and *gjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’a small branch’ and the second ’to divide into items’.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiáojiàn*
- *Say it: tiáojiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ kěyǐ qù kěshì yǒu yí ge tiáojiàn* — I can go, but there’s one condition.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fruits of work, then the Mandarin for to get (a job) done, then say *tiáojiàn* again

Before you move on

What does tiáojiàn mean? (“Condition (that must be met)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 396

Whatever Happens

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about doing something no matter what, since something is so, unless something happens, all day and even if something happens.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 396: I can talk about doing something no matter what, since something is so, unless something happens, all day and even if something happens.*

396.1 bùguǎn — no matter (whether or how)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get (a job) done, then the Mandarin for a condition (that must be met).

You'll want to know: bùguǎn

bùguǎn — "no matter (whether or how)".

> *bùguǎn míngtiān tiānqì zěnmeyàng wǒ dōu qù* — Whatever the weather tomorrow, I'm going.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Tone: 不 keeps its own falling tone here, bù, because guǎn after it is a third tone, not a falling one.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bùguǎn is built from 不 'not' and *guǎn* 'to be in charge', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *kwanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a pipe' and 'to take charge': not caring which.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùguǎn*
- *Say it: bùguǎn*, once more
- *Say it: bùguǎn míngtiān tiānqì zěnmeyàng wǒ dōu qù* — Whatever the weather tomorrow, I'm going.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get (a job) done, then the Mandarin for a condition (that must be met), then say *bùguǎn* again

Before you move on

What does bùguǎn mean? ("No matter (whether or how)".) Say it once more.

396.2 jìrán — given that; now that

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a condition (that must be met), then the Mandarin for no matter (whether or how).

You'll want to know: jìrán

jìrán — "given that; now that".

jìrán nǐ bìng le jiù zài jiā xiūxi — Since you're ill, stay at home and rest.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìrán is built from *jì* 'already' and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kj+jH* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'finished' and the second 'like this'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìrán*
- *Say it: jìrán*, once more
- *Say it: jìrán nǐ bìng le jiù zài jiā xiūxi* — Since you're ill, stay at home and rest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a condition (that must be met), then the Mandarin for no matter (whether or how), then say *jìrán* again

Before you move on

What does jìrán mean? ("Given that; now that".) Say it once more.

396.3 chúfēi — unless

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for no matter (whether or how), then the Mandarin for given that.

You'll want to know: chúfēi

chúfēi — "unless".

chúfēi nǐ bìng le bùrán míngtiān yídìng yào lái — Unless you're ill, be sure to come tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chúfēi is built from *chú* 'to take away' and *fēi* 'not', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjo* and *pj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to remove' and the second 'it is not so'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chúfēi*
- *Say it: chúfēi*, once more
- *Say it: chúfēi nǐ bìng le bùrán míngtiān yídìng yào lái* — Unless you're ill, be sure to come tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for no matter (whether or how), then the Mandarin for given that, then say *chúfēi* again

Before you move on

What does chúfēi mean? ("Unless".) Say it once more.

396.4 全天 (quántiān) — all day; round the clock

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for given that, then the Mandarin for unless.

You'll want to know: 全天

全天 — *quántiān* — "all day; round the clock".

要是晚上要用钱这儿全天都能取钱 *yàoshi wǎnshang yào yòng qián zhèr quántiān dōu néng qǔqián* — If you need cash at night, you can take money out here at any hour.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

全天 (*quántiān*) is built from 全 'whole' and 天 'a day', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjwen* and *then* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: quántiān*
- *Say it: quántiān*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi wǎnshang yào yòng qián zhèr quántiān dōu néng qǔqián* — If you need cash at night, you can take money out here at any hour.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for given that, then the Mandarin for unless, then say *quántiān* again

Before you move on

What does 全天 mean? ("All day; round the clock".) Say it once more.

396.5 jíshǐ — even if

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for unless, then the Mandarin for round the clock.

You'll want to know: jíshǐ

jíshǐ — "even if".

jíshǐ xiàyǔ wǒmen yě yào qù — Even if it rains, we're still going.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jíshǐ is built from *jí* 'to go up to' and *shǐ* 'to make (someone do)', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsik* and *sriX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go to' and 'now' and the second 'to employ' and 'to order'. How the pair came to mean 'even if' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jíshǐ*
- *Say it: jíshǐ*, once more
- *Say it: jíshǐ xiàyǔ wǒmen yě yào qù* — Even if it rains, we're still going.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for unless, then the Mandarin for round the clock, then say *jíshǐ* again

Before you move on

What does jíshǐ mean? ("Even if".) Say it once more.

396.6 Looking back: from A Change of Plan to Whatever Happens

Say the Mandarin for to alter and to change the date.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to alter, to change the date, to make different, to change the name (of), to change one's tune
- *Say it:* to exhort (someone), be sure to (urging), all-purpose, at any time at all, going smoothly

- *Say it:* to succeed, to fail, to take a risk, to be wasted (of effort), staying the same
- *Say it:* to come true, to obtain (through effort), fruits of work, to get (a job) done, a condition (that must be met)
- *Say it:* no matter (whether or how), given that, unless, round the clock, even if
- *Read it:* 改 万 取 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To alter? (改, *gǎi.*) To change the date? (改期, *gǎiqī.*) To make different? (改变, *gǎibiàn.*) To change the name (of)? (改名, *gǎimíng.*) To change one's tune? (改口, *gǎikǒu.*) To exhort (someone)? (*zhǔfu.*) Be sure to (urging)? (千万, *qiānwàn.*) All-purpose? (万能, *wànnéng.*) At any time at all? (*suíshí.*) Going smoothly? (*shùnlì.*) To succeed? (*chénggōng.*) To fail? (*shībài.*) To take a risk? (*màoxiǎn.*) To be wasted (of effort)? (*báifèi.*) Staying the same? (不变, *búbiàn.*) To come true? (*shíxiàn.*) To obtain (through effort)? (取得, *qǔdé.*) Fruits of work? (成果, *chéngguǒ.*) To get (a job) done? (*wánchéng.*) A condition (that must be met)? (*tiáojiàn.*) No matter (whether or how)? (*bùguǎn.*) Given that? (*jìrán.*) Unless? (*chúfēi.*) Round the clock? (全天, *quántiān.*) Even if? (*jíshǐ.*)

Chapter 397

Surely Not

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about being stood up, asking whether something can really be so, rare chances, awkward spots and excuses.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 397: I can talk about being stood up, asking whether something can really be so, rare chances, awkward spots and excuses.*

397.1 fàng gēzi — to stand someone up

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for round the clock, then the Mandarin for even if.

You'll want to know: fàng gēzi

fàng gēzi — "to stand someone up".

> *rúguǒ tā yòu fàng gēzi wǒ jiù bù děng tā le* — If he stands me up again, I won't wait for him any more.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fàng gēzi is built from *fàng* 'to let go' and *gēzi* 'a pigeon', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjangH*, *kop* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the name of a bird'. Letting

the pigeon fly is a modern saying, and how it came to mean standing someone up is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: fàng gēzi*
- *Say it: fàng gēzi*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ tā yòu fàng gēzi wǒ jiù bù děng tā le* — If he stands me up again, I won't wait for him any more.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for round the clock, then the Mandarin for even if, then say *fàng gēzi* again

Before you move on

What does fàng gēzi mean? ("To stand someone up".) Say it once more.

397.2 难道 (nándào) — surely not (in a question)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for even if, then the Mandarin for to stand someone up.

You'll want to know: 难道

难道 — *nándào* — "surely not (in a question)".

难道你不想去吗 *nándào nǐ bù xiǎng qù ma* — Surely you want to go?

The new character, in pieces: 难 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left 又 made narrow, with a dot for its last stroke; on the right the bird piece, eight strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

难道 (*nándào*) is built from 难 'hard' and *dào* 'to say', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'difficult' and the second 'a way'. The sense 'to say' is not given there, and how the pair came to ask whether something can really be so is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: nándào*
- *Say it: nándào*, once more
- *Say it: nándào nǐ bù xiǎng qù ma* — Surely you want to go?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for even if, then the Mandarin for to stand someone up, then say *nándào* again

Before you move on

What does 难道 mean? ("Surely not (in a question)".) Say it once more.

397.3 难 — a narrow 又, then the bird piece

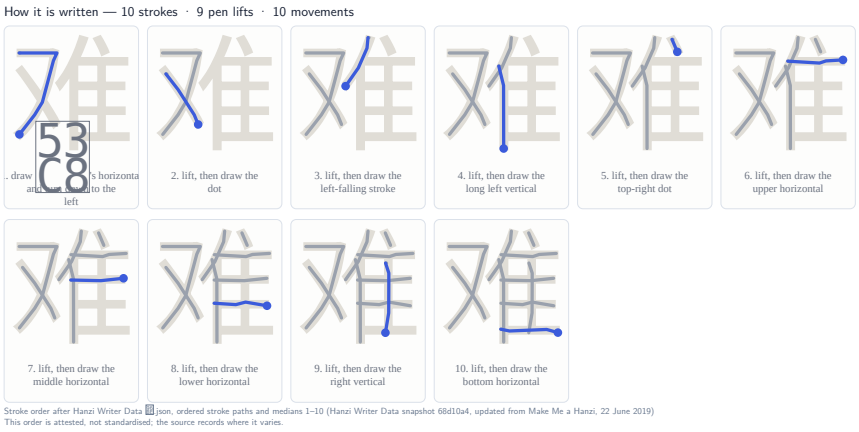
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *nándào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  取 又

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qǔ*, *yòu*

Script — a narrow 又, then the bird piece



How 难 *is written, stroke by stroke*

难

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, 又 made narrow, two strokes: a bar that turns and falls to the lower left, then a dot instead of the long stroke.

The right piece, the bird piece, eight strokes. A stroke falling to the left. A long vertical down from it. A dot at the top right. Three short bars, one under another. A second vertical down through them. Then a long bar across the foot.

2 + 8 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 难, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 难? (**Ten**.) What ends the left piece? (**A dot**.) How many short bars in the bird piece before the long one? (**Three**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 难, pinned stroke paths and medians.

397.4 难得 (nándé) — rare; hard to come by

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stand someone up, then the Mandarin for surely not (in a question).

You'll want to know: 难得

难得 — *nándé* — "rare; hard to come by".

我们难得有时间一起吃饭 *wǒmen nándé yǒu shíjiān yìqǐ chī fàn* — We seldom get time to eat together.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

难得 (*nándé*) is built from 难 'hard' and 得 'to get', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'difficult'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: nándé*
- *Say it: nándé*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen nándé yǒu shíjiān yìqǐ chī fàn* — We seldom get time to eat together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stand someone up, then the Mandarin for surely not (in a question), then say *nándé* again

Before you move on

What does 难得 mean? ("Rare; hard to come by".) Say it once more.

397.5 为难 (wéinán) — in an awkward spot; torn (about what to do)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for surely not (in a question), then the Mandarin for hard to come by.

You'll want to know: 为难

为难 — *wéinán* — "in an awkward spot; torn (about what to do)".

> 我不想说不所以很为难 *wǒ bù xiǎng shuō bù suǒyǐ hěn wéinán* — I don't want to say no, so I'm in an awkward spot.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

为难 (*wéinán*) is built from 为 'to make' and 难 'hard', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwe* and *nan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to do' and the second 'difficult'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: wéinán*
- *Say it: wéinán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bù xiǎng shuō bù suǒyǐ hěn wéinán* — I don't want to say no, so I'm in an awkward spot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for surely not (in a question), then the Mandarin for hard to come by, then say *wéinán* again

Before you move on

What does 为难 mean? ("In an awkward spot; torn (about what to do)".) Say it once more.

397.6 jièkǒu — excuse (a poor reason)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hard to come by, then the Mandarin for in an awkward spot.

You'll want to know: jièkǒu

jièkǒu — "excuse (a poor reason)".

> *yàoshi nǐ bù xiǎng qù jiù bié zhǎo jièkǒu* — If you don't want to go, don't make excuses.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jièkǒu is built from *jiè* 'to borrow' and 口 'a mouth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjaeH* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to borrow': words borrowed to cover the real reason.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jièkǒu*
- *Say it: jièkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ bù xiǎng qù jiù bié zhǎo jièkǒu* — If you don't want to go, don't make excuses.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hard to come by, then the Mandarin for in an awkward spot, then say *jièkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does jièkǒu mean? ("Excuse (a poor reason)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 398

It Depends

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about attitude, the difference between two things, a region, ready-made food and what a plan depends on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 398: I can talk about attitude, the difference between two things, a region, ready-made food and what a plan depends on.*

398.1 tàidu — attitude

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in an awkward spot, then the Mandarin for an excuse (a poor reason).

You'll want to know: tàidu

tàidu — "attitude".

> *néng bu néng chénggōng yào kàn nǐ de tàidu* — Whether you succeed depends on your attitude.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tàidu is built from *tài* 'a bearing' and *dù* 'a measure', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thojH* and *duH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'manner' and the second 'a rule'.

In the word the second loses its tone.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: tàidu*
- *Say it: tàidu*, once more
- *Say it: néng bu néng chénggōng yào kàn nǐ de tàidu* — Whether you succeed depends on your attitude.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in an awkward spot, then the Mandarin for an excuse (a poor reason), then say *tàidu* again

Before you move on

What does tàidu mean? ("Attitude".) Say it once more.

398.2 qūbié — difference

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an excuse (a poor reason), then the Mandarin for your attitude.

You'll want to know: qūbié

qūbié — "difference".

zhè liǎng ge yǒu shénme qūbié — What's the difference between these two?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qūbié is built from 区 'an area' and *bié* 'to part', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khju* and *bjet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'different' and 'to leave'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qūbié*
- *Say it: qūbié*, once more
- *Say it: zhè liǎng ge yǒu shénme qūbié* — What's the difference between these two?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an excuse (a poor reason), then the Mandarin for your attitude, then say *qūbié* again

Before you move on

What does qūbié mean? ("Difference".) Say it once more.

398.3 地区 (dìqū) — region; area (of a country)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for your attitude, then the Mandarin for the difference.

You'll want to know: 地区

地区 — *dìqū* — "region; area (of a country)".

这个地区有一百万人口 *zhège dìqū yǒu yìbǎi wàn rénkǒu* — This region has a million people.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

地区 (*dìqū*) is built from 地 'the ground' and 区 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the land'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìqū*
- *Say it: dìqū*, once more
- *Say it: zhège dìqū yǒu yìbǎi wàn rénkǒu* — This region has a million people.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for your attitude, then the Mandarin for the difference, then say *dìqū* again

Before you move on

What does 地区 mean? ("Region; area (of a country)".) Say it once more.

398.4 现成 (xiànchéng) — ready-made

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the difference, then the Mandarin for a region of a country.

You'll want to know: 现成

现成 — *xiànchéng* — "ready-made".

要是没时间做饭就买现成的 *yàoshi méi shíjiān zuòfàn jiù mǎi xiànchéng de* — If there's no time to cook, buy something ready-made.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

现成 (*xiànchéng*) is built from 现 'to appear' and 成 'complete', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *henH* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to show' and the second 'finished': already there and done.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiànchéng*
- *Say it: xiànchéng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi méi shíjiān zuòfàn jiù mǎi xiànchéng de* — If there's no time to cook, buy something ready-made.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the difference, then the Mandarin for a region of a country, then say *xiànchéng* again

Before you move on

What does 现成 mean? ("Ready-made".) Say it once more.

398.5 qǔjuéyú — to depend on (a factor); to hinge on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a region of a country, then the Mandarin for ready-made.

You'll want to know: qǔjuéyú

qǔjuéyú — "to depend on (a factor); to hinge on".

wǒmen qù bu qù qǔjuéyú tiānqì — Whether we go hinges on the weather.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qǔjuéyú is built from 取 'to take', *jué* 'to decide' and *yú* 'by', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjuX*, *kwet* and *'jo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to break through' and 'to cut' and lists the third as a grammar word: to take its decision from something.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǔjuéyú*
- *Say it: qǔjuéyú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù bu qù qǔjuéyú tiānqì* — Whether we go hinges on the weather.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a region of a country, then the Mandarin for ready-made, then say *qǔjuéyú* again

Before you move on

What does qǔjuéyú mean? ("To depend on (a factor); to hinge on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 399

Only If

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about requirements, the only way something happens, what is enough, meeting a demand and settling down.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 399: I can talk about requirements, the only way something happens, what is enough, meeting a demand and settling down.*

399.1 yāoqiú — to require; to demand (of someone)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for ready-made, then the Mandarin for to hinge on.

You'll want to know: yāoqiú

yāoqiú — "to require; to demand (of someone)".

> *lǎoshī yāoqiú wǒmen měitiān shuō hànyǔ* — The teacher asks us to speak Chinese every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yāoqiú is built from *yāo* 'to press' and *qiú* 'to seek', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jiew* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to force, in common speech' and the second 'to look for'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yāoqiú*
- *Say it: yāoqiú*, once more
- *Say it: lǎoshī yāoqiú wǒmen měitiān shuō hànyǔ* — The teacher asks us to speak Chinese every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for ready-made, then the Mandarin for to hinge on, then say *yāoqiú* again

Before you move on

What does yāoqiú mean? ("To require; to demand (of someone)".) Say it once more.

399.2 只有 (zhǐyǒu) — only if (with cái after it)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hinge on, then the Mandarin for to demand (of someone).

You'll want to know: 只有

只有 — *zhǐyǒu* — "only if (with cái after it)".

只有你去他才会去 *zhǐyǒu nǐ qù tā cái huì qù* — He'll only go if you go.

The new character, in pieces: 只 — five strokes: 口 on top, and 八 under it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Two third tones meet in this word: zhǐ is said with a rising tone before yǒu, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

只有 (*zhǐyǒu*) is built from *zhǐ* 'only' and 有 'to have'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *hjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary lists the first, *tsyeX* there, as a particle.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǐyǒu*
- *Say it: zhǐyǒu*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyǒu nǐ qù tā cái huì qù* — He'll only go if you go.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hinge on, then the Mandarin for to demand (of someone), then say *zhǐyǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 只有 mean? ("Only if (with cái after it)".) Say it once more.

399.3 只 — 口 over 八

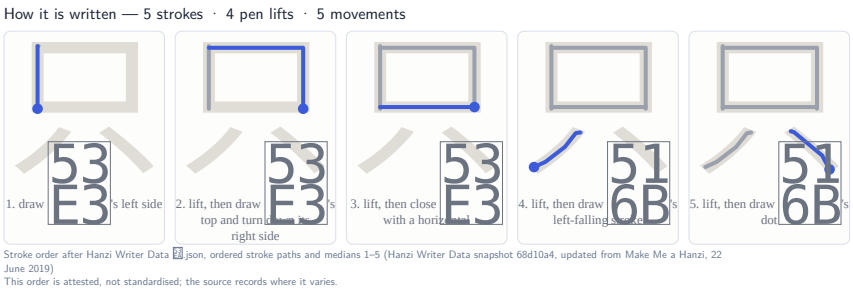
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhǐyǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 八

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *bā*

Script — 口 over 八



How 只 is written, stroke by stroke

只

Two pieces, top before bottom.

口 on top, three strokes, as you wrote it: a short vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, then the bar that closes the foot.

八 under it, two strokes: a stroke falling to the left, then a dot falling to the right.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 只, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 只? (**Five**.) What is on top? (口.) What is under it? (八.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 只, pinned stroke paths and medians.

399.4 只要 (zhǐyào) — as long as; provided (that)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to demand (of someone), then the Mandarin for only if.

You'll want to know: 只要

只要 — *zhǐyào* — "as long as; provided (that)".

> 只要不下雨我们就去 *zhǐyào bú xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù qù* — As long as it doesn't rain, we'll go.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

只要 (*zhǐyào*) is built from 只 'only' and 要 'to need'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to bind by agreement'; the dictionary lists the first, *tsyeX* there, as a particle.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǐyào*
- *Say it: zhǐyào*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào bú xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù qù* — As long as it doesn't rain, we'll go.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to demand (of someone), then the Mandarin for only if, then say *zhǐyào* again

Before you move on

What does 只要 mean? ("As long as; provided (that)".) Say it once more.

399.5 mǎnzú — to meet (a requirement); to satisfy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for only if, then the Mandarin for as long as.

You'll want to know: mǎnzú

mǎnzú — "to meet (a requirement); to satisfy".

> *zhǐyào mǎnzú zhèxiē yāoqiú nǐ jiù néng qù* — As long as you meet these requirements, you can go.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǎnzú is built from *mǎn* 'full' and *zú* 'enough', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *manX* and *tsjowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'brimming' and the second 'the foot' and 'full'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎnzú*
- *Say it: mǎnzú*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào mǎnzú zhèxiē yāoqiú nǐ jiù néng qù* — As long as you meet these requirements, you can go.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for only if, then the Mandarin for as long as, then say *mǎnzú* again

Before you move on

What does mǎnzú mean? ("To meet (a requirement); to satisfy".) Say it once more.

399.6 成家 (chéngjiā) — to marry and settle down

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as long as, then the Mandarin for to meet (a requirement).

You'll want to know: 成家

成家 — *chéngjiā* — "to marry and settle down".

> 只要找到好工作他就想成家 *zhǐyào zhǎodào hǎo gōngzuò tā jiù xiǎng chéngjiā* — As long as he finds a good job, he wants to marry and settle down.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成家 (*chéngjiā*) is built from 成 'to complete' and 家 'a home', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a dwelling'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngjiā*
- *Say it: chéngjiā*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào zhǎodào hǎo gōngzuò tā jiù xiǎng chéngjiā* — As long as he finds a good job, he wants to marry and settle down.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as long as, then the Mandarin for to meet (a requirement), then say *chéngjiā* again

Before you move on

What does 成家 mean? ("To marry and settle down".) Say it once more.

Chapter 400

Moving the Dates

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about adjusting a plan, making a stay longer or a trip shorter, the original plan and a settled life.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 400: I can talk about adjusting a plan, making a stay longer or a trip shorter, the original plan and a settled life.*

400.1 tiáozhěng — to adjust

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to meet (a requirement), then the Mandarin for to marry and settle down.

You'll want to know: tiáozhěng

tiáozhěng — "to adjust".

> *rúguǒ shíjiān bù héshì wǒmen kěyǐ tiáozhěng* — If the time doesn't suit, we can adjust it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiáozhěng is built from *tiáo* 'to put in tune' and *zhěng* 'to put in order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dew* and *tsyengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to harmonise' and the

second 'straight' and 'neat'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiáozhěng*
- *Say it: tiáozhěng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ shíjiān bù héshì wǒmen kěyǐ tiáozhěng* — If the time doesn't suit, we can adjust it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to meet (a requirement), then the Mandarin for to marry and settle down, then say *tiáozhěng* again

Before you move on

What does tiáozhěng mean? ("To adjust".) Say it once more.

400.2 yáncháng — to extend (in time)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to marry and settle down, then the Mandarin for to adjust.

You'll want to know: yáncháng

yáncháng — "to extend (in time)".

yàoshi nǐ xǐhuan zhèr wǒmen kěyǐ yáncháng jiàqī — If you like it here, we can make the holiday longer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yáncháng is built from *yán* 'to stretch' and 长 'long', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yen* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'far' and 'to lengthen'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yáncháng*
- *Say it: yáncháng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ xǐhuan zhèr wǒmen kěyǐ yáncháng jiàqī* — If you like it here, we can make the holiday longer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to marry and settle down, then the Mandarin for to adjust, then say *yáncháng* again

Before you move on

What does yáncháng mean? ("To extend (in time)".) Say it once more.

400.3 suōduǎn — to shorten

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to adjust, then the Mandarin for to extend (in time).

You'll want to know: suōduǎn

suōduǎn — "to shorten".

zuò fēijī kěyǐ suōduǎn yíbàn de shíjiān — Flying can cut the journey time by half.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suōduǎn is built from *suō* 'to draw in' and *duǎn* 'short', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjuwk* and *twanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to shrink' and the second 'not long'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: suōduǎn*
- *Say it: suōduǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zuò fēijī kěyǐ suōduǎn yíbàn de shíjiān* — Flying can cut the journey time by half.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to adjust, then the Mandarin for to extend (in time), then say *suōduǎn* again

Before you move on

What does suōduǎn mean? ("To shorten".) Say it once more.

400.4 yuándìng — originally planned

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to extend (in time), then the Mandarin for to shorten.

You'll want to know: yuándìng

yuándìng — "originally planned".

yuándìng de shíjiān gǎi le — The time we first planned has changed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuándìng is built from *yuán* 'original' and 定 'settled', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwon* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a broad plain'. The sense 'original' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuándìng*
- *Say it: yuándìng*, once more
- *Say it: yuándìng de shíjiān gǎi le* — The time we first planned has changed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to extend (in time), then the Mandarin for to shorten, then say *yuándìng* again

Before you move on

What does yuándìng mean? ("Originally planned".) Say it once more.

400.5 安定 (āndìng) — settled; stable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shorten, then the Mandarin for originally planned.

You'll want to know: 安定

安定 — *āndìng* — "settled; stable".

只有工作安定了我们才能成家 *zhǐyǒu gōngzuò āndìng le wǒmen cái néng chéngjiā* — Only once our jobs are settled can we get married.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

安定 (*āndìng*) is built from 安 'calm' and 定 'settled', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an* and *dengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second with the first: 'calm'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānding*
- *Say it: āndìng*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyǒu gōngzuò āndìng le wǒmen cái néng chéngjiā* — Only once our jobs are settled can we get married.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shorten, then the Mandarin for originally planned, then say *āndìng* again

Before you move on

What does 安定 mean? ("Settled; stable".) Say it once more.

Chapter 401

Plans for the Future

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about prospects, changing career, growing up, getting older and everything being fine.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 401: I can talk about prospects, changing career, growing up, getting older and everything being fine.*

401.1 qiántú — prospects; future (of a person or job)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for originally planned, then the Mandarin for settled and secure.

You'll want to know: qiántú

qiántú — "prospects; future (of a person or job)".

> *wǒ juéde zhège gōngzuò hěn yǒu qiántú* — I think this job has good prospects.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiántú is built from 前 'ahead' and *tú* 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzen* and *du* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a way': the road ahead.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiántú*
- *Say it: qiántú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège gōngzuò hěn yǒu qiántú* — I think this job has good prospects.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for originally planned, then the Mandarin for settled and secure, then say *qiántú* again

Before you move on

What does qiántú mean? ("Prospects; future (of a person or job)".) Say it once more.

401.2 gǎiháng — to change careers

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for settled and secure, then the Mandarin for future prospects.

You'll want to know: gǎiháng

gǎiháng — "to change careers".

yàoshi bù xǐhuan zhège gōngzuò wǒ jiù gǎiháng — If I don't like this job, I'll change careers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎiháng is built from 改 'to alter' and *háng* 'a line', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *hang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a rank' and 'a row'. A line of work is a later sense.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎiháng*
- *Say it: gǎiháng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi bù xǐhuan zhège gōngzuò wǒ jiù gǎiháng* — If I don't like this job, I'll change careers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for settled and secure, then the Mandarin for future prospects, then say *gǎiháng* again

Before you move on

What does gǎiháng mean? ("To change careers".) Say it once more.

401.3 成长 (chéngzhǎng) — to mature (as a person)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for future prospects, then the Mandarin for to change careers.

You'll want to know: 成长

成长 — *chéngzhǎng* — "to mature (as a person)".

孩子成长得很快 *háizi chéngzhǎng de hěn kuài* — Children grow up fast.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成长 (*chéngzhǎng*) is built from 成 'to complete' and 长 'to grow', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'big'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngzhǎng*
- *Say it: chéngzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: háizi chéngzhǎng de hěn kuài* — Children grow up fast.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for future prospects, then the Mandarin for to change careers, then say *chéngzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 成长 mean? ("To mature (as a person)".) Say it once more.

401.4 变老 (biànlǎo) — to get old

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change careers, then the Mandarin for to mature (as a person).

You'll want to know: 变老

变老 — *biànlǎo* — "to get old".

人都会变老 *rén dōu huì biànlǎo* — Everyone gets old.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

变老 (*biànlǎo*) is built from 变 'to change' and 老 'old', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjenH* and *lawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'aged'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: biànlǎo*
- *Say it: biànlǎo*, once more

- *Say it: rén dōu huì biànlǎo* — Everyone gets old.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change careers, then the Mandarin for to mature (as a person), then say *biànlǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 变老 mean? ("To get old".) Say it once more.

401.5 yíqiè — everything; all

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to mature (as a person), then the Mandarin for to get older.

You'll want to know: yíqiè

yíqiè — "everything; all".

zhǐyào nǐ zài yíqiè dōu hǎo — As long as you're here, everything's fine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Tone: 一 is said yí here, rising, because qiè after it is a falling tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yíqiè is built from 一 'one' and *qiè*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jit* and *tshejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second, in this tone, 'the many': all of them as one.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíqiè*
- *Say it: yíqiè*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào nǐ zài yíqiè dōu hǎo* — As long as you're here, everything's fine.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to mature (as a person), then the Mandarin for to get older, then say *yíqiè* again

Before you move on

What does yíqiè mean? ("Everything; all".) Say it once more.

401.6 Looking back: from Surely Not to Plans for the Future

Say the Mandarin for to stand someone up and surely not (in a question).

Your turn

- *Say it:* to stand someone up, surely not (in a question), hard to come by, in an awkward spot, an excuse (a poor reason)
- *Say it:* your attitude, the difference, a region of a country, ready-made, to hinge on
- *Say it:* to demand (of someone), only if, as long as, to meet (a requirement), to marry and settle down
- *Say it:* to adjust, to extend (in time), to shorten, originally planned, settled and secure
- *Say it:* future prospects, to change careers, to mature (as a person), to get older, everything
- *Read it:* 难 只 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To stand someone up? (*fàng gēzi.*) Surely not (in a question)? (难道, *nándào.*) Hard to come by? (难得, *nándé.*) In an awkward spot? (为难, *wéinán.*) An excuse (a poor reason)? (*jièkǒu.*) Your attitude? (*tàidu.*) The difference? (*qūbié.*) A region of a country? (地区, *dìqū.*) Ready-made? (现成, *xiànchéng.*) To hinge on? (*qǔjuéyú.*) To demand (of someone)? (*yāoqiú.*) Only if? (只有, *zhǐyǒu.*) As long as? (只要, *zhǐyào.*) To meet (a requirement)? (*mǎnzú.*) To marry

and settle down? (成家, *chéngjiā.*) To adjust? (*tiáozhěng.*) To extend (in time)? (*yáncháng.*) To shorten? (*suōduǎn.*) Originally planned? (*yuándìng.*) Settled and secure? (安定, *āndìng.*) Future prospects? (*qiántú.*) To change careers? (*gǎiháng.*) To mature (as a person)? (成长, *chéngzhǎng.*) To get older? (变老, *biànlǎo.*) Everything? (*yíqiè.*)

401.7 Plans for the Future — once more

Say the Mandarin for future prospects and to change careers.

Your turn

- *Say it:* future prospects, to change careers, to mature (as a person), to get older, everything

Before you move on

Future prospects? (*qiántú.*) To change careers? (*gǎiháng.*) To mature (as a person)? (成长, *chéngzhǎng.*) To get older? (变老, *biànlǎo.*) Everything? (*yíqiè.*)

Chapter 402

At the Station

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about passengers, the waiting room, fast trains, changing trains and the carriages.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 402: I can talk about passengers, the waiting room, fast trains, changing trains and the carriages.*

402.1 chéngkè — passenger

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get old, then the Mandarin for everything.

You'll want to know: chéngkè

chéngkè — "passenger".

> *huǒchēzhàn lǐ yǒu yìxiē chéngkè* — There are a few passengers in the station.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngkè is built from *chéng* 'to ride' and *kè* 'a guest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zying* and *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to drive', 'to mount' and 'to prevail'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngkè*
- *Say it: chéngkè*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchēzhàn lǐ yǒu yìxiē chéngkè* — There are a few passengers in the station.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get old, then the Mandarin for everything, then say *chéngkè* again

Before you move on

What does chéngkè mean? ("Passenger".) Say it once more.

402.2 候车 (hòuchē) — to wait for a train or bus

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for everything, then the Mandarin for a passenger.

You'll want to know: 候车

候车 — *hòuchē* — "to wait for a train or bus".

我们在车站候车 *wǒmen zài chēzhàn hòuchē* — We're waiting for the train at the station.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

候车 (*hòuchē*) is built from 候 'to wait for' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwH* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to wait upon, to watch for'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòuchē*
- *Say it: hòuchē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài chēzhàn hòuchē* — We're waiting for the train at the station.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for everything, then the Mandarin for a passenger, then say *hòuchē* again

Before you move on

What does 候车 mean? ("To wait for a train or bus".) Say it once more.

402.3 gāotiě — high-speed railway

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a passenger, then the Mandarin for to wait for a train.

You'll want to know: gāotiě

gāotiě — "high-speed railway".

wǒmen zuò gāotiě qù Běijīng — We're taking the high-speed train to Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gāotiě is built from 高 'high' and *tiě* 'iron', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *thet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second, after an older dictionary, 'black metal'. It is a short form of a longer name meaning a high-speed iron road.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāotiě*
- *Say it: gāotiě*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò gāotiě qù Běijīng* — We're taking the high-speed train to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a passenger, then the Mandarin for to wait for a train, then say *gāotiě* again

Before you move on

What does gāotiě mean? ("High-speed railway".) Say it once more.

402.4 huànchéng — to change trains or lines

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wait for a train, then the Mandarin for the high-speed railway.

You'll want to know: huànchéng

huànchéng — "to change trains or lines".

wǒmen zài zhèr huànchéng — We change trains here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huànchéng is built from *huàn* 'to exchange' and *chéng* 'to ride', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwanH* and *zying* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to exchange'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: huànchéng*
- *Say it: huànchéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài zhèr huànchéng* — We change trains here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wait for a train, then the Mandarin for the high-speed railway, then say *huànchéng* again

Before you move on

What does huànchéng mean? ("To change trains or lines".) Say it once more.

402.5 chēxiāng — railway carriage

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the high-speed railway, then the Mandarin for to change trains.

You'll want to know: chēxiāng

chēxiāng — "railway carriage".

wǒmen zuò zài sān hào chēxiāng — We're sitting in carriage three.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chēxiāng is built from 车 'vehicle' and *xiāng* 'a side room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhae* and *sjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a gallery' and the rooms east and west of a hall.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēxiāng*
- *Say it: chēxiāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò zài sān hào chēxiāng* — We're sitting in carriage three.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the high-speed railway, then the Mandarin for to change trains, then say *chēxiāng* again

Before you move on

What does chēxiāng mean? ("Railway carriage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 403

Travellers

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say we were in time for the train, talk about travellers and trains on time, and find the staff.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 403: I can say we were in time for the train, talk about travellers and trains on time, and find the staff.*

403.1 hòuchēshì — station waiting room

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change trains, then the Mandarin for a railway carriage.

You'll want to know: hòuchēshì

hòuchēshì — "station waiting room".

> *nǐ zuò zài hòuchēshì děng wǒ* — Sit in the waiting room and wait for me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hòuchēshì is built from 候车 'to wait for a train' and *shì* 'a room', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwH*, *tsyhae* and *syit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'a room'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòuchēshì*
- *Say it: hòuchēshì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuò zài hòuchēshì děng wǒ* — Sit in the waiting room and wait for me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change trains, then the Mandarin for a railway carriage, then say *hòuchēshì* again

Before you move on

What does hòuchēshì mean? ("Station waiting room".) Say it once more.

403.2 旅客 (lǚkè) — traveller; passenger on a long journey

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a railway carriage, then the Mandarin for a station waiting room.

You'll want to know: 旅客

旅客 — *lǚkè* — "traveller; passenger on a long journey".

旅客都上车了 *lǚkè dōu shàngchē le* — The passengers have all got on.

The new character, in pieces: 旅 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left a dot, a bar, a stroke that runs right and turns down with a hook, and a long stroke falling to the left; on the right a short stroke falling to the left and a bar, then a short stroke falling to the left, a vertical that turns up at the foot, a short stroke falling to the left and a long stroke falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

旅客 (*lǚkè*) is built from 旅 and 客 'a guest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljoX* and *khaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as a body of troops, five hundred men after an older book; the sense 'to travel' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǚkè*
- *Say it: lǚkè*, once more
- *Say it: lǚkè dōu shàngchē le* — The passengers have all got on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a railway carriage, then the Mandarin for a station waiting room, then say *lǚkè* again

Before you move on

What does 旅客 mean? ("Traveller; passenger on a long journey".) Say it once more.

403.3 旅 — a left piece of four strokes, then a right piece of six

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lǚkè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  客 走

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kè*, *zǒu*

Script — a left piece of four strokes, then a right piece of six

How 旅 is written, stroke by stroke

旅

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, four strokes. A dot on top. A bar under it. A stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks to the left at the foot. Then a long stroke falling to the left from under the bar.

The right piece, six strokes. A short stroke falling to the left and a bar to its right, like a small roof. Under them a short stroke falling to the left, a vertical that turns up to the right at the foot, another short stroke falling to the left, and last a long stroke falling to the right.

4 + 6 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 旅, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 旅 have? (**Two: four strokes and six.**)
What is the last stroke? (**A long stroke falling to the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 旅, pinned stroke paths and medians.

403.4 正点 (zhèngdiǎn) — on schedule (of a train or plane)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a station waiting room, then the Mandarin for a passenger on a long journey.

You'll want to know: 正点

正点 — *zhèngdiǎn* — "on schedule (of a train or plane)".

我们的火车正点到了 *wǒmen de huǒchē zhèngdiǎn dào le* — Our train got in on time.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

正点 (*zhèngdiǎn*) is built from 正 'exactly' and 点 'o'clock', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengH* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'right, proper' and the second as a dot made with the brush: on the hour the timetable gives.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngdiǎn*
- *Say it: zhèngdiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de huǒchē zhèngdiǎn dào le* — Our train got in on time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a station waiting room, then the Mandarin for a passenger on a long journey, then say *zhèngdiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 正点 mean? ("On schedule (of a train or plane)".) Say it once more.

403.5 lièchēyuán — train attendant

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a passenger on a long journey, then the Mandarin for on schedule.

You'll want to know: lièchēyuán

lièchēyuán — "train attendant".

zhǎo bu dào zuòwèi dehuà kěyǐ wèn lièchēyuán — If you can't find your seat, ask the train attendant.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lièchēyuán is built from *liè* 'a row', 车 'vehicle' and *yuán* 'a member of staff', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljet*, *tsyhae* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a row, an order' and the third as the number of things; a train is a row of carriages, and the sense 'staff' for the third is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lièchēyuán*
- *Say it: lièchēyuán*, once more
- *Say it: zhǎo bu dào zuòwèi dehuà kěyǐ wèn lièchēyuán* — If you can't find your seat, ask the train attendant.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a passenger on a long journey, then the Mandarin for on schedule, then say *lièchēyuán* again

Before you move on

What does lièchēyuán mean? ("Train attendant".) Say it once more.

403.6 站长 (zhànzhǎng) — stationmaster; head of a station

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for on schedule, then the Mandarin for a train attendant.

You'll want to know: 站长

站长 — *zhànzhǎng* — "stationmaster; head of a station".

旅客去找站长 *lǚkè qù zhǎo zhànzhǎng* — The passenger goes to find the stationmaster.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

站长 (*zhànzhǎng*) is built from 站 'a station' and 长 'the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *treamH* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as an everyday word for standing alone and the second 'big'; a station is usually explained as a place where vehicles stand.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhànzhǎng*
- *Say it: zhànzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: lǚkè qù zhǎo zhànzhǎng* — The passenger goes to find the stationmaster.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for on schedule, then the Mandarin for a train attendant, then say *zhànzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 站长 mean? ("Stationmaster; head of a station".) Say it once more.

Chapter 404

Tickets, Please

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find the ticket office, have my ticket checked, pay on board and choose a berth or a seat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 404: I can find the ticket office, have my ticket checked, pay on board and choose a berth or a seat.*

404.1 shòupiàochù — ticket office

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a train attendant, then the Mandarin for the head of a station.

You'll want to know: shòupiàochù

shòupiàochù — "ticket office".

> *qù shòupiàochù zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the ticket office?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shòupiàochù is built from *shòu* 'to sell', 票 'a ticket' and *chù* 'a place'. The first and the last are inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyuwH* and *tsyhoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to sell goods' and 'a place'; no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shòupiàochù*
- *Say it: shòupiàochù*, once more
- *Say it: qù shòupiàochù zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the ticket office?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a train attendant, then the Mandarin for the head of a station, then say *shòupiàochù* again

Before you move on

What does shòupiàochù mean? ("Ticket office".) Say it once more.

404.2 检票 (jiǎnpiào) — to check tickets

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the head of a station, then the Mandarin for a ticket office.

You'll want to know: 检票

检票 — *jiǎnpiào* — "to check tickets".

现在检票了 *xiànzài jiǎnpiào le* — They're checking tickets now.

The new character, in pieces: 检 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left the tree piece, four strokes, as on the left of 机; on the right a long stroke falling to the left and one falling to the right, like a roof, then a short bar, two dots and a short stroke falling to the left, and a long bar across the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

检票 (*jiǎnpiào*) is built from 检 'to check' and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *kjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as the seal on a document and 'to check'; no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not

settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎnpiào*
- *Say it: jiǎnpiào*, once more
- *Say it: xiànzài jiǎnpiào le* — They're checking tickets now.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the head of a station, then the Mandarin for a ticket office, then say *jiǎnpiào* again

Before you move on

What does 检票 mean? ("To check tickets".) Say it once more.

404.3 检 — the tree piece, then a roof and what is under it

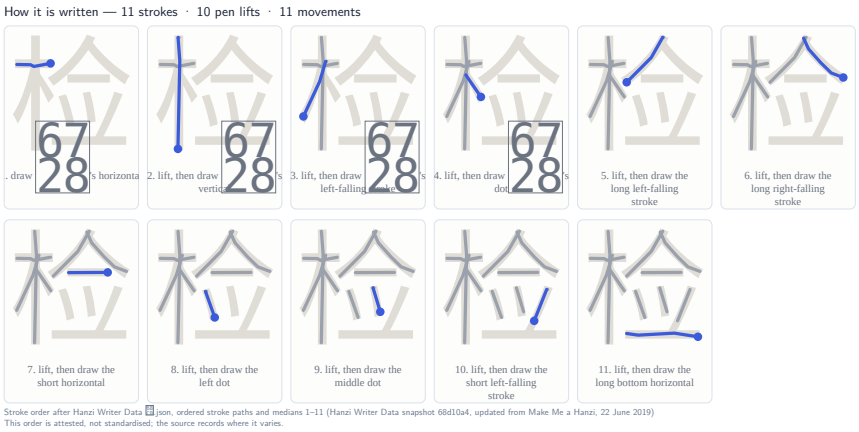
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiǎnpiào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  机 票

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jī*, *piào*

Script — the tree piece, then a roof and what is under it



How 检 is written, stroke by stroke

检

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the tree piece, four strokes. A short bar. A vertical down through it. A stroke falling to the left from the crossing. Then a short dot to the right.

The right piece, seven strokes. A long stroke falling to the left and a long stroke falling to the right: a roof. Under it a short bar. Then two dots side by side and a short stroke falling to the left beside them. Last, a long bar across the foot.

4 + 7 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 检, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 检 have? (**Two.**) Which comes first? (**The tree piece, as in 机.**) What closes the foot? (**A long bar.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 检, pinned stroke paths and medians.

404.4 bǔpiào — to buy a ticket on board

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ticket office, then the Mandarin for to check tickets.

You'll want to know: bǔpiào

bǔpiào — "to buy a ticket on board".

> *méiyǒu piào dehuà kěyǐ shàngchē bǔpiào* — If you've no ticket, you can buy one on the train.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǔpiào is built from *bǔ* 'to mend' and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *puX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to patch'; no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǔpiào*
- *Say it: bǔpiào*, once more
- *Say it: méiyǒu piào dehuà kěyǐ shàngchē bǔpiào* — If you've no ticket, you can buy one on the train.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ticket office, then the Mandarin for to check tickets, then say *bǔpiào* again

Before you move on

What does bǔpiào mean? ("To buy a ticket on board".) Say it once more.

404.5 wòpù — sleeping berth

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to check tickets, then the Mandarin for to buy a ticket on board.

You'll want to know: wòpù

wòpù — "sleeping berth".

wǒ xiǎng mǎi liǎng zhāng wòpù — I'd like two sleeper berths.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wòpù is built from *wò* 'to lie down' and *pù* 'a bed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwaH* and *phuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to sleep' and the second 'to set out, to lay'; the bed sense of the second is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: wòpù*
- *Say it: wòpù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng mǎi liǎng zhāng wòpù* — I'd like two sleeper berths.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to check tickets, then the Mandarin for to buy a ticket on board, then say *wòpù* again

Before you move on

What does wòpù mean? ("Sleeping berth".) Say it once more.

404.6 yìngzuò — hard seat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to buy a ticket on board, then the Mandarin for a sleeping berth.

You'll want to know: yìngzuò

yìngzuò — "hard seat".

> *wǒ zuò yìngzuò qù Běijīng* — I'm going to Beijing in a hard seat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìngzuò is built from *yìng* 'hard' and *zuò* 'a seat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngeangH* and *dzwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'firm' and the second as the seat of a bed.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìngzuò*
- *Say it: yìngzuò*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuò yìngzuò qù Běijīng* — I'm going to Beijing in a hard seat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to buy a ticket on board, then the Mandarin for a sleeping berth, then say *yìngzuò* again

Before you move on

What does yìngzuò mean? ("Hard seat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 405

Through the Gates

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a train goes straight through, go in and out of the station, and talk about the last train.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 405: I can say a train goes straight through, go in and out of the station, and talk about the last train.*

405.1 zhídá — to go direct; to go without changing

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sleeping berth, then the Mandarin for a hard seat.

You'll want to know: zhídá

zhídá — "to go direct; to go without changing".

> *zuò gāotiě kěyǐ zhídá Běijīng* — The high-speed train takes you straight to Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhídá is built from *zhí* 'straight' and *dá* 'to get through', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drik* and *dat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'upright' and the second 'to reach

through’.

What you’ve built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhídá*
- *Say it: zhídá*, once more
- *Say it: zuò gāotiě kěyǐ zhídá Běijīng* — The high-speed train takes you straight to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sleeping berth, then the Mandarin for a hard seat, then say *zhídá* again

Before you move on

What does zhídá mean? (“To go direct; to go without changing”.) Say it once more.

405.2 进入 (jìnrù) — to go into

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hard seat, then the Mandarin for to go without changing.

You’ll want to know: 进入

进入 — *jìnrù* — “to go into”.

wǎng qián zǒu jiù kěyǐ jìnrù chēzhàn — Go straight on and you can get into the station.

The new character, in pieces: 入 — two strokes: a short stroke falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the right that starts higher, above the top of the first. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

进入 (*jìnrù*) is built from 进 'to go forward' and 入 'to go in', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsinH* and *nyip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'forward' and the second 'within' and 'to take in'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnrù*
- *Say it: jìnrù*, once more
- *Say it: wǎng qián zǒu jiù kěyǐ jìnrù chēzhàn* — Go straight on and you can get into the station.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hard seat, then the Mandarin for to go without changing, then say *jìnrù* again

Before you move on

What does 进入 mean? ("To go into".) Say it once more.

405.3 入 — two strokes, the right one on top

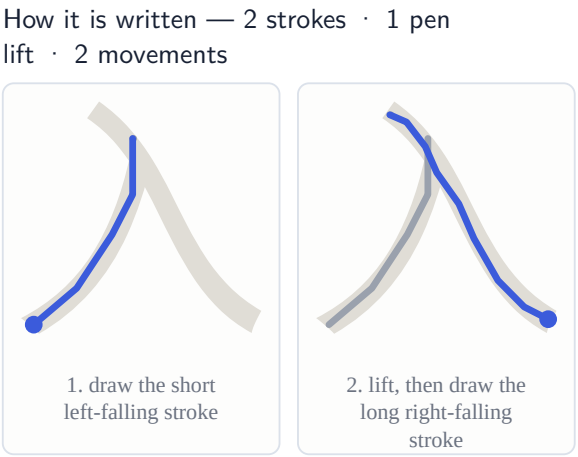
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jìnrù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  人 进

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *jìn*

Script — two strokes, the right one on top



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 65.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–2 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 入 is written, stroke by stroke

入

One piece, two strokes.

First, a short stroke falling to the left, from the middle down to the lower left.

Then a long stroke falling to the right. It starts higher, above the top of the first, and sweeps down to the lower right.

In 人 the left stroke is the long one and the right stroke leans on it; in 入 it is the other way round.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 入, all two, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 入? (**Two**.) Which one starts higher? (**The second, falling to the right**.) How is it unlike 人? (**In 入 the right stroke is the long one**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 入, pinned stroke paths and medians.

405.4 出入 (chūrù) — to go in and out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go without changing, then the Mandarin for to go into a place.

You'll want to know: 出入

出入 — *chūrù* — "to go in and out".

旅客从这个门出入 *lǚkè cóng zhège mén chūrù* — Passengers go in and out through this gate.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出入 (*chūrù*) is built from 出 'to go out' and 入 'to go in', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *nyip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūrù*
- *Say it: chūrù*, once more
- *Say it: lǚkè cóng zhège mén chūrù* — Passengers go in and out through this gate.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go without changing, then the Mandarin for to go into a place, then say *chūrù* again

Before you move on

What does 出入 mean? ("To go in and out".) Say it once more.

405.5 mòbānchē — last bus or train

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go into a place, then the Mandarin for to go in and out.

You'll want to know: mòbānchē

mòbānchē — "last bus or train".

wǒmen zuò mòbānchē qù jīchǎng — We're taking the last train to the airport.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mòbānchē is built from *mò* 'last', *bān* 'a shift' and 车 'vehicle', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *mat*, *paen* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the tip of a tree and 'the end', and the second as dividing jade tokens, so the sense 'a shift, a run' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: mòbānchē*
- *Say it: mòbānchē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò mòbānchē qù jīchǎng* — We're taking the last train to the airport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go into a place, then the Mandarin for to go in and out, then say *mòbānchē* again

Before you move on

What does mòbānchē mean? ("Last bus or train".) Say it once more.

405.6 tíngkào — to call at a station or port

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go in and out, then the Mandarin for the last bus or train.

You'll want to know: tíngkào

tíngkào — "to call at a station or port".

gāotiě zài xiǎo zhàn bù tíngkào — The high-speed train doesn't stop at small stations.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tíngkào is built from *tíng* 'to stop' and *kào* 'to lean against', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *deng* and *khawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rest, to stop' and the second 'to go against each other'; the sense 'to lean on' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíngkào*
- *Say it: tíngkào*, once more
- *Say it: gāotiě zài xiǎo zhàn bù tíngkào* — The high-speed train doesn't stop at small stations.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go in and out, then the Mandarin for the last bus or train, then say *tíngkào* again

Before you move on

What does tíngkào mean? (“To call at a station or port”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 406

A Busy Platform

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a place is crowded, talk about a round trip, change a booking and talk about cars and racks.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 406: I can say a place is crowded, talk about a round trip, change a booking and talk about cars and racks.*

406.1 yōngjǐ — crowded

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the last bus or train, then the Mandarin for to call at a station.

You'll want to know: yōngjǐ

yōngjǐ — "crowded".

> *dìtiě tài yōngjǐ le wǒmen zuò chūzūchē qù* — The metro's too crowded: we'll take a taxi.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yōngjǐ is built from *yōng* 'to hold close' and *jǐ* 'to squeeze', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jowngX* and *tsej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold in the arms' and the second 'to push aside'. Those forms would regularly give yǒng

and jī: the tones of yōngjǐ are irregular.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yōngjǐ*
- *Say it: yōngjǐ*, once more
- *Say it: dìtiě tài yōngjǐ le wǒmen zuò chūzūchē qù* — The metro's too crowded: we'll take a taxi.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the last bus or train, then the Mandarin for to call at a station, then say *yōngjǐ* again

Before you move on

What does yōngjǐ mean? ("Crowded".) Say it once more.

406.2 来回 (láihuí) — round trip

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to call at a station, then the Mandarin for crowded.

You'll want to know: 来回

来回 — *láihuí* — "round trip".

cóng zhèr dào jīchǎng yí ge láihuí yào liǎng ge xiǎoshí — A round trip from here to the airport takes two hours.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

来回 (*láihuí*) is built from 来 'to come' and 回 'to go back', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *loj* and *hwoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to arrive' and the second 'to turn'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: láihuí*
- *Say it: láihuí*, once more
- *Say it: cóng zhèr dào jīchǎng yí ge láihuí yào liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — A round trip from here to the airport takes two hours.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to call at a station, then the Mandarin for crowded, then say *láihuí* again

Before you move on

What does 来回 mean? ("Round trip".) Say it once more.

406.3 gǎiqiān — to change a booking; to change a ticket to another train

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for crowded, then the Mandarin for a round trip.

You'll want to know: gǎiqiān

gǎiqiān — "to change a booking; to change a ticket to another train".

wǒ xiǎng gǎiqiān míngtiān de huǒchē — I'd like to change to tomorrow's train.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎiqiān is built from *gǎi* 'to alter' and *qiān* 'to sign'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *kojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to change'; no dictionary we use records an older form of the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎiqiān*
- *Say it: gǎiqiān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng gǎiqiān míngtiān de huǒchē* — I'd like to change to tomorrow's train.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for crowded, then the Mandarin for a round trip, then say *gǎiqiān* again

Before you move on

What does gǎiqiān mean? ("To change a booking; to change a ticket to another train".) Say it once more.

406.4 qìchē — motor vehicle; car

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a round trip, then the Mandarin for to change a booking.

You'll want to know: qìchē

qìchē — "motor vehicle; car".

wǒmen zuò qìchē qù jīchǎng — We're going to the airport by car.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qìchē is built from *qì* 'steam' and 车 'vehicle'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: qìchē*
- *Say it: qìchē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò qìchē qù jīchǎng* — We're going to the airport by car.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a round trip, then the Mandarin for to change a booking, then say *qìchē* again

Before you move on

What does qìchē mean? ("Motor vehicle; car".) Say it once more.

406.5 xínglijià — luggage rack

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change a booking, then the Mandarin for a motor car.

You'll want to know: xínglijià

xínglijià — "luggage rack".

zhège xínglijià hěn gāo — This luggage rack is very high.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xínglijià is built from *xíngli* 'luggage' and *jià* 'a frame', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeng*, *liX* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last as the frame of a house.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xínglijià*
- *Say it: xínglijià*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xínglijià hěn gāo* — This luggage rack is very high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change a booking, then the Mandarin for a motor car, then say *xínglijià* again

Before you move on

What does xínglijià mean? ("Luggage rack".) Say it once more.

Chapter 407

Pulling In

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a train is pulling in, name the soft sleeper, find an empty seat and reach the end of the line.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 407: I can say a train is pulling in, name the soft sleeper, find an empty seat and reach the end of the line.*

407.1 进站 (jìnzhàn) — to pull into the station (of a train or bus)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a motor car, then the Mandarin for a luggage rack.

You'll want to know: 进站

进站 — *jìnzhàn* — "to pull into the station (of a train or bus)".

> 火车进站了现在检票 *huǒchē jìnzhàn le xiànzài jiǎnpiào* — The train's pulling in: they're checking tickets now.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

进站 (*jìnzhàn*) is built from 进 'to go forward, to go in' and 站 'a station', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsinH* and *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnzhàn*
- *Say it: jìnzhàn*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē jìnzhàn le xiànzài jiǎnpiào* — The train's pulling in: they're checking tickets now.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a motor car, then the Mandarin for a luggage rack, then say *jìnzhàn* again

Before you move on

What does 进站 mean? ("To pull into the station (of a train or bus)".) Say it once more.

407.2 ruǎnwò — soft sleeper

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a luggage rack, then the Mandarin for to pull into the station.

You'll want to know: ruǎnwò

ruǎnwò — "soft sleeper".

ruǎnwò bǐ yìngzuò guì — A soft sleeper costs more than a hard seat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ruǎnwò is built from *ruǎn* 'soft' and *wò* 'to lie down', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nywenX* and *ngwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'soft' and the second 'to sleep'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: ruǎnwò*
- *Say it: ruǎnwò*, once more
- *Say it: ruǎnwò bǐ yìngzuò guì* — A soft sleeper costs more than a hard seat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a luggage rack, then the Mandarin for to pull into the station, then say *ruǎnwò* again

Before you move on

What does ruǎnwò mean? ("Soft sleeper".) Say it once more.

407.3 kòngwèi — empty seat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pull into the station, then the Mandarin for a soft sleeper.

You'll want to know: kòngwèi

kòngwèi — "empty seat".

wǒ zài chē lǐ zhǎo bu dào kòngwèi — I can't find an empty seat on the bus.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kòngwèi is built from *kòng* 'vacant' and *wèi* 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuwngH* and *hwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'empty, lacking' and the second as a place in a row.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kòngwèi*
- *Say it: kòngwèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài chē lǐ zhǎo bu dào kòngwèi* — I can't find an empty seat on the bus.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pull into the station, then the Mandarin for a soft sleeper, then say *kòngwèi* again

Before you move on

What does kòngwèi mean? ("Empty seat".) Say it once more.

407.4 zhōngdiǎnzhàn — terminus; the end of the line

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a soft sleeper, then the Mandarin for an empty seat.

You'll want to know: zhōngdiǎnzhàn

zhōngdiǎnzhàn — "terminus; the end of the line".

wǒmen zài zhōngdiǎnzhàn xià chē — We get off at the last stop.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhōngdiǎnzhàn is built from *zhōng* 'the end', 点 'a point' and 站 'a station', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuwng*, *temX* and *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the utmost, the end'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōngdiǎnzhàn*
- *Say it: zhōngdiǎnzhàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài zhōngdiǎnzhàn xià chē* — We get off at the last stop.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a soft sleeper, then the Mandarin for an empty seat, then say *zhōngdiǎnzhàn* again

Before you move on

What does zhōngdiǎnzhàn mean? ("Terminus; the end of the line".) Say it once more.

407.5 dòngchē — D-class bullet train

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an empty seat, then the Mandarin for the end of the line.

You'll want to know: dòngchē

dòngchē — "D-class bullet train".

> *zuò dòngchē qù Běijīng yào duōjiǔ* — How long does the bullet train take to Beijing?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dòngchē is built from *dòng* 'to move' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwngX* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stir, to move'. It is a short form of a longer name, a train whose carriages move under their own power.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dòngchē*
- *Say it: dòngchē*, once more
- *Say it: zuò dòngchē qù Běijīng yào duōjiǔ* — How long does the bullet train take to Beijing?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an empty seat, then the Mandarin for the end of the line, then say *dòngchē* again

Before you move on

What does dòngchē mean? ("D-class bullet train".) Say it once more.

407.6 Looking back: from At the Station to Pulling In

Say the Mandarin for a passenger and to wait for a train.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a passenger, to wait for a train, the high-speed railway, to change trains, a railway carriage
- *Say it:* a station waiting room, a passenger on a long journey, on schedule, a train attendant, the head of a station
- *Say it:* a ticket office, to check tickets, to buy a ticket on board, a sleeping berth, a hard seat
- *Say it:* to go without changing, to go into a place, to go in and out, the last bus or train, to call at a station
- *Say it:* crowded, a round trip, to change a booking, a motor car, a luggage rack

- *Say it:* to pull into the station, a soft sleeper, an empty seat, the end of the line, a D-class bullet train
- *Read it:* 旅 检 入 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A passenger? (*chéngkè.*) To wait for a train? (候车, *hòuchē.*) The high-speed railway? (*gāotiě.*) To change trains? (*huànchéng.*) A railway carriage? (*chēxiāng.*) A station waiting room? (*hòuchēshì.*) A passenger on a long journey? (旅客, *lǚkè.*) On schedule? (正点, *zhèngdiǎn.*) A train attendant? (*lièchēyuán.*) The head of a station? (站长, *zhànzhǎng.*) A ticket office? (*shòupiàochù.*) To check tickets? (检票, *jiǎnpiào.*) To buy a ticket on board? (*bǔpiào.*) A sleeping berth? (*wòpù.*) A hard seat? (*yìngzuò.*) To go without changing? (*zhídá.*) To go into a place? (进入, *jìnrù.*) To go in and out? (出入, *chūrù.*) The last bus or train? (*mòbānchē.*) To call at a station? (*tíngkào.*) Crowded? (*yōngjǐ.*) A round trip? (来回, *láihuí.*) To change a booking? (*gǎiqiān.*) A motor car? (*qìchē.*) A luggage rack? (*xínglijià.*) To pull into the station? (进站, *jìnzhàn.*) A soft sleeper? (*ruǎnwò.*) An empty seat? (*kòngwèi.*) The end of the line? (*zhōngdiǎnzhàn.*) A D-class bullet train? (*dòngchē.*)

Chapter 408

By Bus

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find the bus stop, take public transport, pay with coins and say where a route starts.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 408: I can find the bus stop, take public transport, pay with coins and say where a route starts.*

408.1 zhànpái — bus stop sign

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the end of the line, then the Mandarin for a D-class bullet train.

You'll want to know: zhànpái

zhànpái — "bus stop sign".

> *wǒ zài zhànpái xiàbian děng nǐ* — I'll wait for you under the bus stop sign.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhànpái is built from 站 'a stop' and *pái* 'a board', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *treamH* and *bea* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a signboard.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhànpái*
- *Say it: zhànpái*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài zhànpái xiàbian děng nǐ* — I'll wait for you under the bus stop sign.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the end of the line, then the Mandarin for a D-class bullet train, then say *zhànpái* again

Before you move on

What does zhànpái mean? ("Bus stop sign".) Say it once more.

408.2 公交 (gōngjiāo) — public transport

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a D-class bullet train, then the Mandarin for a bus stop sign.

You'll want to know: 公交

公交 — *gōngjiāo* — "public transport".

我每天坐公交去学校 *wǒ měitiān zuò gōngjiāo qù xuéxiào* — I take public transport to school every day.

The new character, in pieces: 交 — six strokes: a dot and a bar on top; under them a short stroke falling to the left and a short dot falling to the right; then a long stroke falling to the left, crossed by a long stroke falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

公交 (*gōngjiāo*) is built from 公 'public' and 交 'to cross', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *kaew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'shared' and the second

'to join'. It is a short form of a longer name for public transport; the city bus is *gōngjiāochē*.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngjiāo*
- *Say it: gōngjiāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měitiān zuò gōngjiāo qù xuéxiào* — I take public transport to school every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a D-class bullet train, then the Mandarin for a bus stop sign, then say *gōngjiāo* again

Before you move on

What does 公交 mean? ("Public transport".) Say it once more.

408.3 交 — a lid, then two strokes crossing

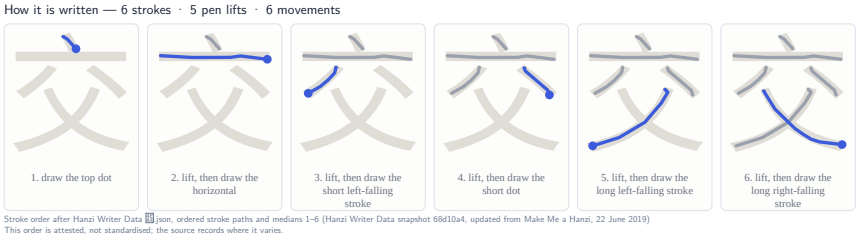
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gōngjiāo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  文 公

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wén*, *gōng*

Script — a lid, then two strokes crossing



How 交 is written, stroke by stroke

交

Two pieces, top to bottom.

The lid, two strokes. A dot, then a long bar across, as on top of 文.

The lower piece, four strokes. A short stroke falling to the left and a short dot falling to the right, apart, like two feet. Then a long stroke falling to the left, and across it a long stroke falling to the right to the foot.

2 + 4 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 交, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 交? (**Six.**) What sits on top? (**A dot and a bar, as on 文.**) What are the last two strokes? (**A long fall to the left, crossed by a long fall to the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 交, pinned stroke paths and medians.

408.4 tóubì — to drop coins in the box

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bus stop sign, then the Mandarin for public transport.

You'll want to know: tóubì

tóubì — "to drop coins in the box".

> *shàng chē yǐhòu qǐng tóubì* — Please put your coins in once you're on.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóubì is built from *tóu* 'to throw' and *bì* 'money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duw* and *bjiejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as gifts of silk; the sense 'coin' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóubì*
- *Say it: tóubì*, once more
- *Say it: shàng chē yǐhòu qǐng tóubì* — Please put your coins in once you're on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bus stop sign, then the Mandarin for public transport, then say *tóubì* again

Before you move on

What does tóubì mean? ("To drop coins in the box".) Say it once more.

408.5 客车 (kèchē) — coach; long-distance bus

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for public transport, then the Mandarin for to drop coins in the box.

You'll want to know: 客车

客车 — *kèchē* — "coach; long-distance bus".

> **我们坐客车去那儿** *wǒmen zuò kèchē qù nàr* — We're going there by coach.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

客车 (*kèchē*) is built from **客** 'a guest' and **车** 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaek* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a vehicle that carries people, not goods.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kèchē*
- *Say it: kèchē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò kèchē qù nàr* — We're going there by coach.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for public transport, then the Mandarin for to drop coins in the box, then say *kèchē* again

Before you move on

What does **客车** mean? ("Coach; long-distance bus".) Say it once more.

408.6 起点 (qǐdiǎn) — starting point

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to drop coins in the box, then the Mandarin for a long-distance coach.

You'll want to know: 起点

起点 — *qǐdiǎn* — "starting point".

公交的起点在火车站 *gōngjiāo de qǐdiǎn zài huǒchēzhàn* — The bus route starts at the railway station.

Two third tones meet in this word: qǐ is said with a rising tone before diǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

起点 (*qǐdiǎn*) is built from 起 'to rise, to start' and 点 'a point', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khiX* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and the second as a dot.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐdiǎn*
- *Say it: qǐdiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: gōngjiāo de qǐdiǎn zài huǒchēzhàn* — The bus route starts at the railway station.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to drop coins in the box, then the Mandarin for a long-distance coach, then say *qǐdiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 起点 mean? ("Starting point".) Say it once more.

Chapter 409

Heavy Traffic

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about rush hour and the traffic, say a line opens, find the conductor and take a taxi.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 409: I can talk about rush hour and the traffic, say a line opens, find the conductor and take a taxi.*

409.1 gāofēng — peak (of traffic); rush hour

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a long-distance coach, then the Mandarin for a starting point.

You'll want to know: gāofēng

gāofēng — "peak (of traffic); rush hour".

> *gāofēng de shíhou zài chē lǐ zhǎo bu dào zuòwèi* — At rush hour you can't find a seat on the bus.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gāofēng is built from 高 'high' and *fēng* 'a peak', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *phjowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the second under another spelling, glossed as a mountain peak.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāofēng*
- *Say it: gāofēng*, once more
- *Say it: gāofēng de shíhou zài chē lǐ zhǎo bu dào zuòwèi* — At rush hour you can't find a seat on the bus.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a long-distance coach, then the Mandarin for a starting point, then say *gāofēng* again

Before you move on

What does gāofēng mean? ("Peak (of traffic); rush hour".) Say it once more.

409.2 交通 (jiāotōng) — traffic; transport

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a starting point, then the Mandarin for the rush hour.

You'll want to know: 交通

交通 — *jiāotōng* — "traffic; transport".

zhèr de jiāotōng hěn fāngbiàn — It's easy to get around here.

The new character, in pieces: 通 — ten strokes in two pieces: the right piece first, seven strokes, a short bar that turns down to the left with a dot under it, then a frame with two short bars and a vertical through them; the walking piece of 这, three strokes, sits under it and is written last. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

交通 (*jiāotōng*) is built from 交 'to cross' and 通 'to go through', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaew* and *thuwng* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to reach through'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāotōng*
- *Say it: jiāotōng*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de jiāotōng hěn fāngbiàn* — It's easy to get around here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a starting point, then the Mandarin for the rush hour, then say *jiāotōng* again

Before you move on

What does 交通 mean? ("Traffic; transport".) Say it once more.

409.3 通 — the right piece first, then the walking piece under it

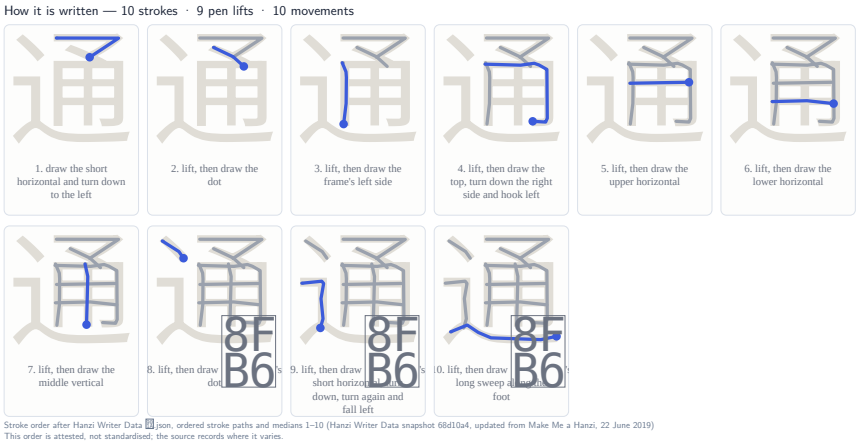
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiāotōng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  这 过

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhè*, *guò*

Script — the right piece first, then the walking piece under it



How 通 *is written, stroke by stroke*

通

Two pieces, and the walking piece comes last. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The right piece, seven strokes. A short bar that turns down to the left, and a dot under its end. A vertical down the left. A bar across the top that turns down the right side and hooks to the left at the foot. Two short bars inside. Then a vertical down through the middle.

The walking piece, three strokes, as in 这: a dot, a stroke that zigzags down, then a long sweep along the foot under the whole character.

7 + 3 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 通, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 通? (**Ten.**) Which piece comes last? (**The walking piece, as in 这.**) What runs down through the middle of

the right piece? (**A vertical**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 通, pinned stroke paths and medians.

409.4 通车 (tōngchē) — to open to traffic

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the rush hour, then the Mandarin for the traffic on the roads.

You'll want to know: 通车

通车 — *tōngchē* — "to open to traffic".

zhèr de dìtiě míngnián tōngchē — The metro here opens next year.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

通车 (*tōngchē*) is built from 通 'to go through' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thuwng* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): vehicles can go through.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōngchē*
- *Say it: tōngchē*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de dìtiě míngnián tōngchē* — The metro here opens next year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the rush hour, then the Mandarin for the traffic on the roads, then say *tōngchē* again

Before you move on

What does 通车 mean? ("To open to traffic".) Say it once more.

409.5 shòupiàoyuán — ticket seller; bus conductor

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the traffic on the roads, then the Mandarin for to open to traffic.

You'll want to know: shòupiàoyuán

shòupiàoyuán — "ticket seller; bus conductor".

shòupiàoyuán zuò zài ménkǒu — The conductor sits by the door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shòupiàoyuán is built from *shòu* 'to sell', 票 'a ticket' and *yuán* 'a member of staff'. The first and the last are inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyuwH* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shòupiàoyuán*
- *Say it: shòupiàoyuán*, once more
- *Say it: shòupiàoyuán zuò zài ménkǒu* — The conductor sits by the door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the traffic on the roads, then the Mandarin for to open to traffic, then say *shòupiàoyuán* again

Before you move on

What does shòupiàoyuán mean? ("Ticket seller; bus conductor".) Say it once more.

409.6 打车 (dǎchē) — to take a taxi

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to open to traffic, then the Mandarin for a ticket seller.

You'll want to know: 打车

打车 — *dǎchē* — "to take a taxi".

下雨的时候不好打车 *xià yǔ de shíhou bù hǎo dǎchē* — When it rains it's hard to get a taxi.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

打车 (*dǎchē*) is built from **打** and **车** 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike'. The sense 'to hire' in this word is not given there, and *taengX* would regularly give a different final, so dǎ is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎchē*
- *Say it: dǎchē*, once more
- *Say it: xià yǔ de shíhou bù hǎo dǎchē* — When it rains it's hard to get a taxi.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to open to traffic, then the Mandarin for a ticket seller, then say *dǎchē* again

Before you move on

What does **打车** mean? ("To take a taxi".) Say it once more.

Chapter 410

Long Trips

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about long-distance coaches and fares, say a train passes through, a line opens and we set off.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 410: I can talk about long-distance coaches and fares, say a train passes through, a line opens and we set off.*

410.1 chángtú — long-distance

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ticket seller, then the Mandarin for to take a taxi.

You'll want to know: chángtú

chángtú — "long-distance".

> *zuò chángtú chē qù hěn lèi* — Going by long-distance coach is tiring.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chángtú is built from 长 'long' and *tú* 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjang* and *du* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a road'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chángtú*
- *Say it: chángtú*, once more
- *Say it: zuò chángtú chē qù hěn lèi* — Going by long-distance coach is tiring.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ticket seller, then the Mandarin for to take a taxi, then say *chángtú* again

Before you move on

What does chángtú mean? ("Long-distance".) Say it once more.

410.2 chēfèi — fare for a ride

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take a taxi, then the Mandarin for long-distance.

You'll want to know: chēfèi

chēfèi — "fare for a ride".

zuò chūzūchē qù jīchǎng chēfèi shì duōshao qián — How much is the taxi fare to the airport?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chēfèi is built from 车 'vehicle' and *fèi* 'a cost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhae* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to use up'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēfèi*
- *Say it: chēfèi*, once more
- *Say it: zuò chūzūchē qù jīchǎng chēfèi shì duōshao qián* — How much is the taxi fare to the airport?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take a taxi, then the Mandarin for long-distance, then say *chēfèi* again

Before you move on

What does chēfèi mean? ("Fare for a ride".) Say it once more.

410.3 通过 (tōngguò) — to pass through

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for long-distance, then the Mandarin for the fare for a ride.

You'll want to know: 通过

通过 — *tōngguò* — "to pass through".

检票以后我们从这儿通过 *jiǎnpiào yǐhòu wǒmen cóng zhèr tōngguò* — After the ticket check we go through here.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

通过 (*tōngguò*) is built from 通 'to go through' and 过 'to cross', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thuwng* and *kwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to go beyond'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōngguò*
- *Say it: tōngguò*, once more
- *Say it: jiǎnpiào yǐhòu wǒmen cóng zhèr tōngguò* — After the ticket check we go through here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for long-distance, then the Mandarin for the fare for a ride, then say *tōngguò* again

Before you move on

What does 通过 mean? ("To pass through".) Say it once more.

410.4 开通 (kāitōng) — to launch a new transport line

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the fare for a ride, then the Mandarin for to pass through.

You'll want to know: 开通

开通 — *kāitōng* — "to launch a new transport line".

wǒmen zhèr kāitōng le gāotiě — High-speed rail has opened in our area.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开通 (*kāitōng*) is built from 开 'to open' and 通 'to go through', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *thuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāitōng*
- *Say it: kāitōng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhèr kāitōng le gāotiě* — High-speed rail has opened in our area.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the fare for a ride, then the Mandarin for to pass through, then say *kāitōng* again

Before you move on

What does 开通 mean? ("To launch a new transport line".) Say it once more.

410.5 上路 (shànglù) — to set out on a journey; to hit the road

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pass through, then the Mandarin for to launch a new transport line.

You'll want to know: 上路

上路 — *shànglù* — "to set out on a journey; to hit the road".

我们早上六点上路 *wǒmen zǎoshang liù diǎn shànglù* — We set off at six in the morning.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上路 (*shànglù*) is built from 上 'to go up' and 路 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to climb'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shànglù*
- *Say it: shànglù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zǎoshang liù diǎn shànglù* — We set off at six in the morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pass through, then the Mandarin for to launch a new transport line, then say *shànglù* again

Before you move on

What does 上路 mean? ("To set out on a journey; to hit the road".) Say it once more.

Chapter 411

On the Water

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the pier, the captain, a boat setting sail, the ferry and life jackets.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 411: I can talk about the pier, the captain, a boat setting sail, the ferry and life jackets.*

411.1 mǎtou — pier; wharf

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to launch a new transport line, then the Mandarin for to hit the road.

You'll want to know: mǎtou

mǎtou — "pier; wharf".

> *qù mǎtou zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the pier?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǎtou is built from *mǎ* and the noun ending *tou*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maeX* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first only in the name of agate, a stone like jade, and the second as 'the head'; how the pair came to mean a pier is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎtou*
- *Say it: mǎtou*, once more
- *Say it: qù mǎtou zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the pier?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to launch a new transport line, then the Mandarin for to hit the road, then say *mǎtou* again

Before you move on

What does mǎtou mean? ("Pier; wharf".) Say it once more.

411.2 船长 (chuánzhǎng) — ship's captain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hit the road, then the Mandarin for a pier for boats.

You'll want to know: 船长

船长 — *chuánzhǎng* — "ship's captain".

我想当船长 *wǒ xiǎng dāng chuánzhǎng* — I want to be a ship's captain.

The new character, in pieces: 船 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left the boat piece, six strokes, a short stroke falling to the left, a long one down the left, a bar that turns down and hooks, a dot, a bar rising across and a last dot; on the right a short stroke falling to the left and a bar that turns down and bends right, then 口 under them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

船长 (*chuánzhǎng*) is built from 船 'a boat' and 长 'the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zywen* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'big'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuánzhǎng*
- *Say it: chuánzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng dāng chuánzhǎng* — I want to be a ship's captain.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hit the road, then the Mandarin for a pier for boats, then say *chuánzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 船长 mean? ("Ship's captain".) Say it once more.

411.3 船 — the boat piece, then 口 under a small frame

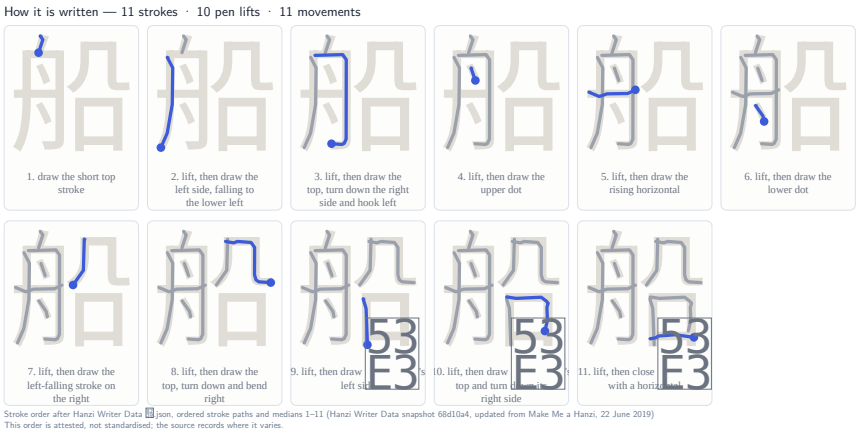
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chuánzhǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 长

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *cháng*

Script — the boat piece, then 口 under a small frame



How 船 is written, stroke by stroke

船

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the boat piece, six strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A long stroke down the left side, falling to the left at the foot. A bar that turns down the right side and hooks to the left. A dot inside, a bar rising to the right across the middle, and a last dot under it.

The right piece, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left, and a bar that turns down and bends to the right at the foot: a small frame. Then 口 under it, three strokes.

6 + 5 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 船, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 船 have? (**Two.**) What is the left piece? (**The boat piece, six strokes.**) What sits at the foot of the right

piece? (口.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 船, pinned stroke paths and medians.

411.4 开船 (kāichuán) — to set sail

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pier for boats, then the Mandarin for a ship's captain.

You'll want to know: 开船

开船 — *kāichuán* — "to set sail".

船长说十点开船 *chuánzhǎng shuō shí diǎn kāichuán* — The captain says we sail at ten.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开船 (*kāichuán*) is built from 开 'to start off' and 船 'a boat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to open'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāichuán*
- *Say it: kāichuán*, once more
- *Say it: chuánzhǎng shuō shí diǎn kāichuán* — The captain says we sail at ten.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pier for boats, then the Mandarin for a ship's captain, then say *kāichuán* again

Before you move on

What does 开船 mean? ("To set sail".) Say it once more.

411.5 dùchuán — ferry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ship's captain, then the Mandarin for to set sail.

You'll want to know: dùchuán

dùchuán — "ferry".

wǒmen zuò dùchuán qù nàr — We're taking the ferry over there.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dùchuán is built from *dù* 'to cross water' and 船 'a boat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duH* and *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to cross over'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dùchuán*
- *Say it: dùchuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò dùchuán qù nàr* — We're taking the ferry over there.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ship's captain, then the Mandarin for to set sail, then say *dùchuán* again

Before you move on

What does dùchuán mean? ("Ferry".) Say it once more.

411.6 救生衣 (jiùshēngyī) — life jacket

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to set sail, then the Mandarin for a ferry across the water.

You'll want to know: 救生衣

救生衣 — *jiùshēngyī* — "life jacket".

> *zuò chuán de shíhou yào chuān jiùshēngyī* — On a boat you have to wear a life jacket.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

救生衣 (*jiùshēngyī*) is built from *jiù* 'to save', **生** 'life' and **衣** 'clothes', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjuwH*, *srjaeng* and *'j+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to protect'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiùshēngyī*
- *Say it: jiùshēngyī*, once more
- *Say it: zuò chuán de shíhou yào chuān jiùshēngyī* — On a boat you have to wear a life jacket.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to set sail, then the Mandarin for a ferry across the water, then say *jiùshēngyī* again

Before you move on

What does **救生衣** mean? ("Life jacket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 412

Harbour and Deck

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the harbour, the deck and the cabins, a boat coming in to shore and a passenger ship.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 412: I can talk about the harbour, the deck and the cabins, a boat coming in to shore and a passenger ship.*

412.1 gǎngkǒu — port; harbour

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ferry across the water, then the Mandarin for a life jacket.

You'll want to know: gǎngkǒu

gǎngkǒu — "port; harbour".

> *zhège gǎngkǒu hěn dà* — This harbour is very big.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: gǎng is said with a rising tone before kǒu, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎngkǒu is built from *gǎng* 'a harbour' and 口 'a mouth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngX* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a branch of a river.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎngkǒu*
- *Say it: gǎngkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: zhège gǎngkǒu hěn dà* — This harbour is very big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ferry across the water, then the Mandarin for a life jacket, then say *gǎngkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does gǎngkǒu mean? ("Port; harbour".) Say it once more.

412.2 jiǎbǎn — ship's deck

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a life jacket, then the Mandarin for a harbour for ships.

You'll want to know: jiǎbǎn

jiǎbǎn — "ship's deck".

wǒmen qù jiǎbǎn kàn dàhǎi — Let's go up on deck and look at the sea.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: jiǎ is said with a rising tone before bǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎbǎn is built from *jiǎ* 'a shell, armour' and *bǎn* 'a board', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaep* and *paenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as armour; how the pair came to mean a ship's deck is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎbǎn*
- *Say it: jiǎbǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù jiǎbǎn kàn dàhǎi* — Let's go up on deck and look at the sea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a life jacket, then the Mandarin for a harbour for ships, then say *jiǎbǎn* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎbǎn mean? ("Ship's deck".) Say it once more.

412.3 chuáncāng — ship's cabin

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a harbour for ships, then the Mandarin for the ship's deck.

You'll want to know: chuáncāng

chuáncāng — "ship's cabin".

nǐ de bāo fàng zài chuáncāng lǐ — Leave your bag in the cabin.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuáncāng is built from 船 'a boat' and *cāng* 'a cabin'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuáncāng*
- *Say it: chuáncāng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de bāo fàng zài chuáncāng lǐ* — Leave your bag in the cabin.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a harbour for ships, then the Mandarin for the ship's deck, then say *chuáncāng* again

Before you move on

What does chuáncāng mean? ("Ship's cabin".) Say it once more.

412.4 kào'àn — to come in to shore

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the ship's deck, then the Mandarin for a ship's cabin.

You'll want to know: kào'àn

kào'àn — "to come in to shore".

chuán mǎshàng yào kào'àn le — The boat is about to come in.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kào'àn is built from *kào* 'to lean against' and *àn* 'a shore', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khawH* and *nganH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the high bank of a river; the sense 'to lean on' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kào'àn*
- *Say it: kào'àn*, once more
- *Say it: chuán mǎshàng yào kào'àn le* — The boat is about to come in.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the ship's deck, then the Mandarin for a ship's cabin, then say *kào'àn* again

Before you move on

What does kào'àn mean? ("To come in to shore".) Say it once more.

412.5 客船 (kèchuán) — passenger ship

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ship's cabin, then the Mandarin for to come in to shore.

You'll want to know: 客船

客船 — *kèchuán* — "passenger ship".

我们坐客船去那儿 *wǒmen zuò kèchuán qù nàr* — We're going there on a passenger ship.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

客船 (*kèchuán*) is built from 客 'a guest' and 船 'a boat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaek* and *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kèchuán*
- *Say it: kèchuán*, once more

- *Say it: wǒmen zuò kèchuán qù nàr* — We're going there on a passenger ship.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ship's cabin, then the Mandarin for to come in to shore, then say *kèchuán* again

Before you move on

What does 客船 mean? ("Passenger ship".) Say it once more.

Chapter 413

Up in the Air

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can board a plane, say how high it flies, talk about the captain and landing, and say time flies.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 413: I can board a plane, say how high it flies, talk about the captain and landing, and say time flies.*

413.1 dēngjī — to board a plane

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come in to shore, then the Mandarin for a passenger ship.

You'll want to know: dēngjī

dēngjī — "to board a plane".

> *dēngjī yǐqián wǒmen zuò zài zhèr děng* — Until we board, we'll sit here and wait.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēngjī is built from *dēng* 'to go up' and 机 'a plane', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and, after an older dictionary, 'to get up into a carriage'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēngjī*
- *Say it: dēngjī*, once more
- *Say it: dēngjī yǐqián wǒmen zuò zài zhèr děng* — Until we board, we'll sit here and wait.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come in to shore, then the Mandarin for a passenger ship, then say *dēngjī* again

Before you move on

What does dēngjī mean? ("To board a plane".) Say it once more.

413.2 飞 (fēi) — to fly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a passenger ship, then the Mandarin for to board a plane.

You'll want to know: 飞

飞 — *fēi* — "to fly".

飞机飞得很高 *fēijī fēi de hěn gāo* — The plane is flying very high.

The new character, in pieces: 飞 — three strokes: a bar that turns and slants down to the right, ending in a hook up; then a short stroke falling to the left and a dot, near the top on the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

飞 (*fēi*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *pj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to fly, to soar'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēi*
- *Say it: fēi*, once more
- *Say it: fēijī fēi de hěn gāo* — The plane is flying very high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a passenger ship, then the Mandarin for to board a plane, then say *fēi* again

Before you move on

What does 飞 mean? ("To fly".) Say it once more.

413.3 飞 — a hooked turn, then two small strokes

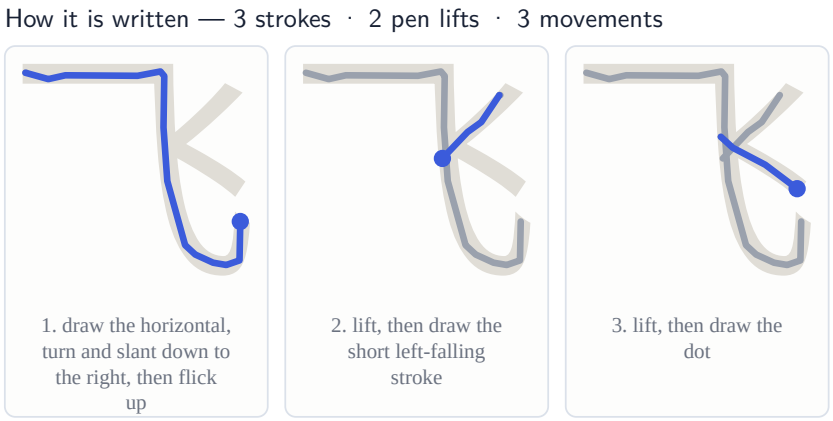
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *fēi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  机 起

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jī*, *qǐ*

Script — a hooked turn, then two small strokes



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data data.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–3 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 乛 is written, stroke by stroke

乛

One piece, three strokes.

First, a bar to the right that turns and slants down to the right, then flicks up at the end: one stroke, without lifting the pen.

Then a short stroke falling to the left, on the right of the turn.

Last, a dot under it, falling to the right.

One long stroke and two short ones: three.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 乛, all three, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 乛? (**Three**.) Which stroke is the longest? (**The first, the bar that turns and hooks**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 乛, pinned stroke paths and medians.

413.4 机长 (jīzhǎng) — plane's captain; pilot in command

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to board a plane, then the Mandarin for to fly.

You'll want to know: 机长

机长 — *jīzhǎng* — "plane's captain; pilot in command".

> 机长说飞机马上要到了 *jīzhǎng shuō fēijī mǎshàng yào dào le* — The captain says we'll be there soon.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

机长 (*jīzhǎng*) is built from 机 'a plane' and 长 'the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kj+j* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīzhǎng*
- *Say it: jīzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: jīzhǎng shuō fēijī mǎshàng yào dào le* — The captain says we'll be there soon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to board a plane, then the Mandarin for to fly, then say *jīzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 机长 mean? ("Plane's captain; pilot in command".) Say it once more.

413.5 jiàngluò — to land; to come down onto the runway

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fly, then the Mandarin for the pilot in command.

You'll want to know: jiàngluò

jiàngluò — "to land; to come down onto the runway".

> *fēijī jiàngluò yǐhòu wǒmen zuò dìtiě qù bīnguǎn* — Once the plane has landed, we'll take the metro to the hotel.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàngluò is built from *jiàng* 'to come down' and *luò* 'to fall', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewngH* and *lak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'down, to come down' and the second as leaves falling from a tree.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàngluò*
- *Say it: jiàngluò*, once more
- *Say it: fēijī jiàngluò yǐhòu wǒmen zuò dìtiě qù bīnguǎn* — Once the plane has landed, we'll take the metro to the hotel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fly, then the Mandarin for the pilot in command, then say *jiàngluò* again

Before you move on

What does jiàngluò mean? ("To land; to come down onto the runway".) Say it once more.

413.6 飞快 (fēikuài) — very fast; as fast as flying

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the pilot in command, then the Mandarin for to come down onto the runway.

You'll want to know: 飞快

飞快 — *fēikuài* — "very fast; as fast as flying".

时间过得飞快 *shíjiān guò de fēikuài* — Time flies.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

飞快 (*fēikuài*) is built from 飞 'to fly' and 快 'fast', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pj+j* and *khwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to one's liking'; the sense 'fast' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēikuài*
- *Say it: fēikuài*, once more
- *Say it: shíjiān guò de fēikuài* — Time flies.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the pilot in command, then the Mandarin for to come down onto the runway, then say *fēikuài* again

Before you move on

What does 飞快 mean? ("Very fast; as fast as flying".) Say it once more.

413.7 Looking back: from By Bus to Up in the Air

Say the Mandarin for a bus stop sign and public transport.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a bus stop sign, public transport, to drop coins in the box, a long-distance coach, a starting point
- *Say it:* the rush hour, the traffic on the roads, to open to traffic, a ticket seller, to take a taxi
- *Say it:* long-distance, the fare for a ride, to pass through, to launch a new transport line, to hit the road
- *Say it:* a pier for boats, a ship's captain, to set sail, a ferry across the water, a life jacket
- *Say it:* a harbour for ships, the ship's deck, a ship's cabin, to come in to shore, a passenger ship
- *Say it:* to board a plane, to fly, the pilot in command, to come down onto the runway, as fast as flying
- *Read it:* 交 通 船 飞 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A bus stop sign? (*zhànpái.*) Public transport? (公交, *gōngjiāo.*) To drop coins in the box? (*tóubì.*) A long-distance coach? (客车, *kèchē.*) A starting point? (起点, *qǐdiǎn.*) The rush hour? (*gāofēng.*) The traffic on the roads? (交通, *jiāotōng.*) To open to traffic? (通车, *tōngchē.*) A ticket seller? (*shòupiàoyuán.*) To take a taxi? (打车, *dǎchē.*) Long-distance? (*chángtú.*) The fare for a ride? (*chēfèi.*) To pass through? (通过, *tōngguò.*) To launch a new transport line? (开通, *kāitōng.*) To hit the road? (上路, *shànglù.*) A pier for boats? (*mǎtou.*) A ship's captain? (船长, *chuánzhǎng.*) To set sail? (开船, *kāichuán.*) A ferry across the water? (*dùchuán.*) A life jacket? (救生衣, *jiùshēngyī.*) A harbour for ships? (*gǎngkǒu.*) The ship's deck? (*jiǎbǎn.*) A ship's cabin? (*chuáncāng.*) To come in to shore? (*kào'àn.*) A passenger ship? (客船, *kèchuán.*) To board a plane? (*dēngjī.*) To fly? (飞, *fēi.*) The pilot in command? (机长, *jīzhǎng.*) To come down onto the runway? (*jiàngluò.*) As fast as flying? (飞快, *fēikuài.*)

Chapter 414

In the Cabin

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the cabin crew, a window seat, economy class, feeling sick and the seat belt.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 414: I can talk about the cabin crew, a window seat, economy class, feeling sick and the seat belt.*

414.1 chéngwùyuán — flight attendant; cabin crew

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come down onto the runway, then the Mandarin for as fast as flying.

You'll want to know: chéngwùyuán

chéngwùyuán — "flight attendant; cabin crew".

> *chéngwùyuán zhǎohuí le wǒ de shǒujī* — The flight attendant found my phone for me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngwùyuán is built from *chéng* 'to ride', *wù* 'a task' and *yuán* 'a member of staff', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *zying*, *mjuH* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second

'business, affairs'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngwùyuán*
- *Say it: chéngwùyuán*, once more
- *Say it: chéngwùyuán zhǎohuí le wǒ de shǒujī* — The flight attendant found my phone for me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come down onto the runway, then the Mandarin for as fast as flying, then say *chéngwùyuán* again

Before you move on

What does chéngwùyuán mean? ("Flight attendant; cabin crew".) Say it once more.

414.2 kàochuāng — next to the window

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as fast as flying, then the Mandarin for a flight attendant.

You'll want to know: kàochuāng

kàochuāng — "next to the window".

wǒ xiǎng yào yí ge kàochuāng de zuòwèi — I'd like a window seat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kàochuāng is built from *kào* 'to be next to' and *chuāng* 'a window', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khawH* and *tsrhaewng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second, after

an older dictionary, as an opening through a wall.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kàochuāng*
- *Say it: kàochuāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng yào yí ge kàochuāng de zuòwèi* — I'd like a window seat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as fast as flying, then the Mandarin for a flight attendant, then say *kàochuāng* again

Before you move on

What does kàochuāng mean? ("Next to the window".) Say it once more.

414.3 jīngjìcāng — economy class

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a flight attendant, then the Mandarin for next to the window.

You'll want to know: jīngjìcāng

jīngjìcāng — "economy class".

wǒmen zuò jīngjìcāng qù Běijīng — We're flying to Beijing in economy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīngjìcāng is built from *jīngjì* 'economy' and *cāng* 'a cabin'. The first two parts are inherited from Middle Chinese, *keng* and *tsejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'constant' and 'to cross

a river'; no dictionary we use records an older form of the third, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīngjìcāng*
- *Say it: jīngjìcāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò jīngjìcāng qù Běijīng* — We're flying to Beijing in economy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a flight attendant, then the Mandarin for next to the window, then say *jīngjìcāng* again

Before you move on

What does jīngjìcāng mean? ("Economy class".) Say it once more.

414.4 yùnjī — to get airsick

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for next to the window, then the Mandarin for economy class.

You'll want to know: yùnjī

yùnjī — "to get airsick".

wǒ zuò fēijī de shíhou huì yùnjī — I get airsick when I fly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùnjī is built from *yùn* 'dizzy' and 机 'a plane'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first, *hjunH* there, as a halo round the sun or moon, so how it came to mean dizziness is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùnjī*
- *Say it: yùnjī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuò fēijī de shíhou huì yùnjī* — I get airsick when I fly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for next to the window, then the Mandarin for economy class, then say *yùnjī* again

Before you move on

What does yùnjī mean? ("To get airsick".) Say it once more.

414.5 ānquándài — seat belt

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for economy class, then the Mandarin for to get airsick.

You'll want to know: ānquándài

ānquándài — "seat belt".

měi ge zuòwèi dōu yǒu ānquándài — Every seat on the plane has a seat belt.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ānquándài is built from *ānquán* 'safe' and *dài* 'a belt', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an*, *dzjwen* and *tajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last as a sash worn with clothes.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānquándài*
- *Say it: ānquándài*, once more
- *Say it: měi ge zuòwèi dōu yǒu ānquándài* — Every seat on the plane has a seat belt.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for economy class, then the Mandarin for to get airsick, then say *ānquándài* again

Before you move on

What does ānquándài mean? ("Seat belt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 415

The Terminal

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find the terminal, check in a bag, show my boarding pass, go through security and find the gate.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 415: I can find the terminal, check in a bag, show my boarding pass, go through security and find the gate.*

415.1 hángzhànlóu — airport terminal

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get airsick, then the Mandarin for a seat belt.

You'll want to know: hángzhànlóu

hángzhànlóu — "airport terminal".

> *wǒmen de hángbān zài èr hào hángzhànlóu* — Our flight goes from terminal two.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hángzhànlóu is built from *háng* 'to sail, to fly', 站 'a station' and *lóu* 'a building', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *hang*, *treamH* and *luw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a boat' and the third as a building of several storeys.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hángzhànlóu*
- *Say it: hángzhànlóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de hángbān zài èr hào hángzhànlóu* — Our flight goes from terminal two.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get airsick, then the Mandarin for a seat belt, then say *hángzhànlóu* again

Before you move on

What does hángzhànlóu mean? ("Airport terminal".) Say it once more.

415.2 tuōyùn — to check in a suitcase; to send luggage in the hold

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a seat belt, then the Mandarin for an airport terminal building.

You'll want to know: tuōyùn

tuōyùn — "to check in a suitcase; to send luggage in the hold".

zhège xiāngzi yào tuōyùn — This suitcase needs to be checked in.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuōyùn is built from *tuō* 'to entrust' and *yùn* 'to carry', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thak* and *hjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the first under another spelling, 'to entrust', and glosses the second 'to move, to carry'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuōyùn*
- *Say it: tuōyùn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xiāngzi yào tuōyùn* — This suitcase needs to be checked in.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a seat belt, then the Mandarin for an airport terminal building, then say *tuōyùn* again

Before you move on

What does tuōyùn mean? ("To check in a suitcase; to send luggage in the hold".) Say it once more.

415.3 dēngjīpái — boarding pass

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an airport terminal building, then the Mandarin for to check in a suitcase.

You'll want to know: dēngjīpái

dēngjīpái — "boarding pass".

wǒ de dēngjīpái bú jiàn le — My boarding pass has gone missing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēngjīpái is built from *dēngjī* 'to board a plane' and *pái* 'a card', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong*, *kj+j* and *bea* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last as a signboard.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēngjīpái*
- *Say it: dēngjīpái*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de dēngjīpái bú jiàn le* — My boarding pass has gone missing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an airport terminal building, then the Mandarin for to check in a suitcase, then say *dēngjīpái* again

Before you move on

What does dēngjīpái mean? ("Boarding pass".) Say it once more.

415.4 安检 (ānjiǎn) — security check

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to check in a suitcase, then the Mandarin for a boarding pass.

You'll want to know: 安检

安检 — *ānjiǎn* — "security check".

我们先去安检 *wǒmen xiān qù ānjiǎn* — We'll go through security first.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

安检 (*ānjiǎn*) is built from *ān* 'safe' and 检 'to check', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'an* and *kjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); it is a short form of a longer name, a safety check.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: ānjiǎn*
- *Say it: ānjiǎn*, once more

- *Say it: wǒmen xiān qù ānjiǎn* — We'll go through security first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to check in a suitcase, then the Mandarin for a boarding pass, then say *ānjiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 安检 mean? ("Security check".) Say it once more.

415.5 dēngjīkǒu — departure gate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a boarding pass, then the Mandarin for the security check at an airport.

You'll want to know: dēngjīkǒu

dēngjīkǒu — "departure gate".

qù shí hào dēngjīkǒu zěnme zǒu — How do I get to gate ten?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēngjīkǒu is built from *dēngjī* 'to board a plane' and 口 'an opening', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong*, *kj+j* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēngjīkǒu*
- *Say it: dēngjīkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: qù shí hào dēngjīkǒu zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to gate ten?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a boarding pass, then the Mandarin for the security check at an airport, then say *dēngjīkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does dēngjīkǒu mean? (“Departure gate”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 416

A Storm

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a flight is held up by a storm, that someone missed a plane, and talk about changing planes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 416: I can say a flight is held up by a storm, that someone missed a plane, and talk about changing planes.*

416.1 yánwù — to be delayed; to be held up

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the security check at an airport, then the Mandarin for a departure gate.

You'll want to know: yánwù

yánwù — "to be delayed; to be held up".

> *hángbān yánwù le wǒmen yào zài jīchǎng zài děng liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — The flight's delayed: we have to wait at the airport two more hours.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yánwù is built from *yán* 'to draw out' and *wù* 'a mistake', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yen* and *nguH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stretch, to lengthen' and the

second 'an error'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yánwù*
- *Say it: yánwù*, once more
- *Say it: hángbān yánwù le wǒmen yào zài jīchǎng zài děng liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — The flight's delayed: we have to wait at the airport two more hours.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the security check at an airport, then the Mandarin for a departure gate, then say *yánwù* again

Before you move on

What does yánwù mean? ("To be delayed; to be held up".) Say it once more.

416.2 场 (chǎng) — measure word for a rainstorm; measure word for a game or a show

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a departure gate, then the Mandarin for to be held up.

You'll want to know: 场

场 — *chǎng* — "measure word for a rainstorm; measure word for a game or a show".

今天有一场大雨 *jīntiān yǒu yì chǎng dà yǔ* — There's a big storm today.

The new character, in pieces: 场 — six strokes in two pieces: on the left the earth piece of 地, a bar, a vertical and a bar rising to the right; on the right a bar that turns down and zigzags to a hook, then two strokes falling to the left. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

场 (*chǎng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as a place for offerings to the spirits and a threshing floor; how it came to count spells of rain and games is not settled. *drjang* would regularly give a rising tone, cháng; the falling-rising tone of the measure word is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǎng*
- *Say it: chǎng*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān yǒu yì chǎng dà yǔ* — There's a big storm today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a departure gate, then the Mandarin for to be held up, then say *chǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 场 mean? ("Measure word for a rainstorm; measure word for a game or a show".) Say it once more.

416.3 场 — the earth piece, then a zigzag and two sweeps

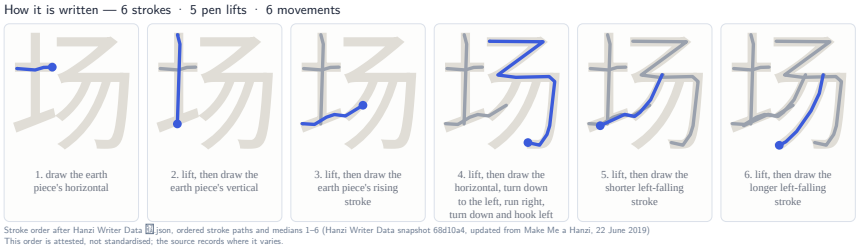
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  地 机

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dì*, *jī*

Script — the earth piece, then a zigzag and two sweeps



How 场 is written, stroke by stroke

场

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes, as on the left of 地: a short bar, a vertical down through it, then a bar that rises to the right at the foot.

The right piece, three strokes. A bar to the right that turns down, zigzags and ends in a hook to the left: one stroke. Then two strokes falling to the left inside it, the second longer.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 场, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 场? (**Six.**) What is the left piece? (**The earth piece, as in 地.**) How many strokes falling to the left at the end? (**Two.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 场, pinned stroke paths and medians.

416.4 wùjī — to miss a flight

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be held up, then the Mandarin for the measure word for a rainstorm.

You'll want to know: wùjī

wùjī — "to miss a flight".

> *wǒmen zuò chūzūchē qù jīchǎng bùrán huì wùjī* — Let's take a taxi to the airport, or we'll miss the plane.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wùjī is built from *wù* 'to miss' and 机 'a plane', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nguH* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'an error'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: wùjī*
- *Say it: wùjī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò chūzūchē qù jīchǎng bùrán huì wùjī* — Let's take a taxi to the airport, or we'll miss the plane.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be held up, then the Mandarin for the measure word for a rainstorm, then say *wùjī* again

Before you move on

What does wùjī mean? ("To miss a flight".) Say it once more.

416.5 zhuǎnjī — to change planes

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the measure word for a rainstorm, then the Mandarin for to miss a flight.

You'll want to know: zhuǎnjī

zhuǎnjī — "to change planes".

> *wǒmen yào zài Běijīng zhuǎnjī* — We have to change planes in Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuǎnjī is built from *zhuǎn* 'to turn' and 机 'a plane', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjwenX* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move, to turn'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuǎnjī*
- *Say it: zhuǎnjī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yào zài Běijīng zhuǎnjī* — We have to change planes in Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the measure word for a rainstorm, then the Mandarin for to miss a flight, then say *zhuǎnjī* again

Before you move on

What does zhuǎnjī mean? ("To change planes".) Say it once more.

416.6 fēixíng — flight; flying (of an aircraft)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to miss a flight, then the Mandarin for to change planes on the way.

You'll want to know: fēixíng

fēixíng — "flight; flying (of an aircraft)".

> *cóng zhèr zuò fēijī qù Běijīng fēixíng shíjiān shì liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — Flying from here to Beijing takes two hours.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fēixíng is built from 飞 'to fly' and *xíng* 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pj+j* and *haeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to walk, to go'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēixíng*
- *Say it: fēixíng*, once more
- *Say it: cóng zhèr zuò fēijī qù Běijīng fēixíng shíjiān shì liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — Flying from here to Beijing takes two hours.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to miss a flight, then the Mandarin for to change planes on the way, then say *fēixíng* again

Before you move on

What does fēixíng mean? ("Flight; flying (of an aircraft)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 417

Customs

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can go through customs, come into and leave a country, declare things and buy duty-free.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 417: I can go through customs, come into and leave a country, declare things and buy duty-free.*

417.1 hǎiguān — customs at the border

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to change planes on the way, then the Mandarin for flying (of an aircraft).

You'll want to know: hǎiguān

hǎiguān — "customs at the border".

> *qù hǎiguān zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to customs?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎiguān is built from *hǎi* 'the sea' and *guān* 'a barrier', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xojX* and *kwaen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a bar across a gate; how the pair came to mean customs is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎiguān*
- *Say it: hǎiguān*, once more
- *Say it: qù hǎiguān zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to customs?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to change planes on the way, then the Mandarin for flying (of an aircraft), then say *hǎiguān* again

Before you move on

What does hǎiguān mean? ("Customs at the border".) Say it once more.

417.2 rùjìng — to enter a country

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for flying (of an aircraft), then the Mandarin for customs at the border.

You'll want to know: rùjìng

rùjìng — "to enter a country".

rùjìng yào yòng hùzhào — You need a passport to enter the country.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rùjìng is built from 入 'to go in' and *jìng* 'a border', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyip* and *kjaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a boundary'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: rùjìng*
- *Say it: rùjìng*, once more
- *Say it: rùjìng yào yòng hùzhào* — You need a passport to enter the country.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for flying (of an aircraft), then the Mandarin for customs at the border, then say *rùjìng* again

Before you move on

What does rùjìng mean? ("To enter a country".) Say it once more.

417.3 chūjìng — to leave a country

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for customs at the border, then the Mandarin for to enter a country.

You'll want to know: chūjìng

chūjìng — "to leave a country".

chūjìng de shíhou tāmen kàn le wǒ de hùzhào — When I left the country, they looked at my passport.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūjìng is built from 出 'to go out' and *jìng* 'a border', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *kjaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūjìng*
- *Say it: chūjìng*, once more
- *Say it: chūjìng de shíhou tāmen kàn le wǒ de hùzhào* — When I left the country, they looked at my passport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for customs at the border, then the Mandarin for to enter a country, then say *chūjìng* again

Before you move on

What does chūjìng mean? ("To leave a country".) Say it once more.

417.4 shēnbào — to declare goods at customs

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to enter a country, then the Mandarin for to leave a country.

You'll want to know: shēnbào

shēnbào — "to declare goods at customs".

nǐ yǒu dōngxi yào shēnbào ma — Do you have anything to declare?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēnbào is built from *shēn* 'to state' and *bào* 'to report', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syin* and *pawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stretch' and 'to repeat' and the second 'to report'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnbào*
- *Say it: shēnbào*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ yǒu dōngxi yào shēnbào ma* — Do you have anything to declare?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to enter a country, then the Mandarin for to leave a country, then say *shēnbào* again

Before you move on

What does shēnbào mean? ("To declare goods at customs".) Say it once more.

417.5 miǎnshuì — duty-free; tax-free

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leave a country, then the Mandarin for to declare goods at customs.

You'll want to know: miǎnshuì

miǎnshuì — "duty-free; tax-free".

jīchǎng lǐ yǒu yì jiā miǎnshuì de shāngdiàn — There's a duty-free shop in the airport.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

miǎnshuì is built from *miǎn* 'to be spared' and *shuì* 'a tax', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjenX* and *sywejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to put off, to escape' and the second 'a levy'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: miǎnshuì*
- *Say it: miǎnshuì*, once more
- *Say it: jīchǎng lǐ yǒu yì jiā miǎnshuì de shāngdiàn* — There's a duty-free shop in the airport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leave a country, then the Mandarin for to declare goods at customs, then say *miǎnshuì* again

Before you move on

What does miǎnshuì mean? ("Duty-free; tax-free".) Say it once more.

Chapter 418

Checking In

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can check in for a flight, go through the formalities, say flights are grounded and a bag is too heavy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 418: I can check in for a flight, go through the formalities, say flights are grounded and a bag is too heavy.*

418.1 zhíjī — to check in for a flight

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to declare goods at customs, then the Mandarin for duty-free.

You'll want to know: zhíjī

zhíjī — "to check in for a flight".

> *wǒmen xiān zhíjī ránhòu qù ānjiǎn* — First we check in, then we go through security.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhíjī is built from *zhí* 'to be on duty' and 机 'a plane', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *driH* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hold' and 'to meet with'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíjī*
- *Say it: zhíjī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen xiān zhíjī ránhòu qù ānjiǎn* — First we check in, then we go through security.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to declare goods at customs, then the Mandarin for duty-free, then say *zhíjī* again

Before you move on

What does zhíjī mean? ("To check in for a flight".) Say it once more.

418.2 shǒuxù — formalities; procedure

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for duty-free, then the Mandarin for to check in for a flight.

You'll want to know: shǒuxù

shǒuxù — "formalities; procedure".

chūguó de shǒuxù hěn máfan — The formalities for going abroad are a real bother.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǒuxù is built from 手 'a hand' and *xù* 'to carry on', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *zjowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to continue, to join'; how the pair came to mean formalities is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒuxù*
- *Say it: shǒuxù*, once more
- *Say it: chūguó de shǒuxù hěn máfan* — The formalities for going abroad are a real bother.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for duty-free, then the Mandarin for to check in for a flight, then say *shǒuxù* again

Before you move on

What does shǒuxù mean? ("Formalities; procedure".) Say it once more.

418.3 停飞 (tíngfēi) — to be grounded (of planes)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to check in for a flight, then the Mandarin for the formalities.

You'll want to know: 停飞

停飞 — *tíngfēi* — "to be grounded (of planes)".

fēijī tíngfēi le wǒmen zuò gāotiě qù Běijīng — The planes are grounded: we're taking the high-speed train to Beijing.

The new character, in pieces: 停 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left the person piece 亻; on the right a dot and a bar, a small 口, a short stroke down and a bar that hooks like a lid, a bar, and a vertical with a hook. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

停飞 (*tíngfēi*) is built from 停 'to stop' and 飞 'to fly', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *deng* and *pj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'to rest, to stop' and the second 'to fly, to soar'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíngfēi*
- *Say it: tíngfēi*, once more
- *Say it: fēijī tíngfēi le wǒmen zuò gāotiě qù Běijīng* — The planes are grounded: we're taking the high-speed train to Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to check in for a flight, then the Mandarin for the formalities, then say *tíngfēi* again

Before you move on

What does 停飞 mean? ("To be grounded (of planes)".) Say it once more.

418.4 停 — the person piece, then a tall right side

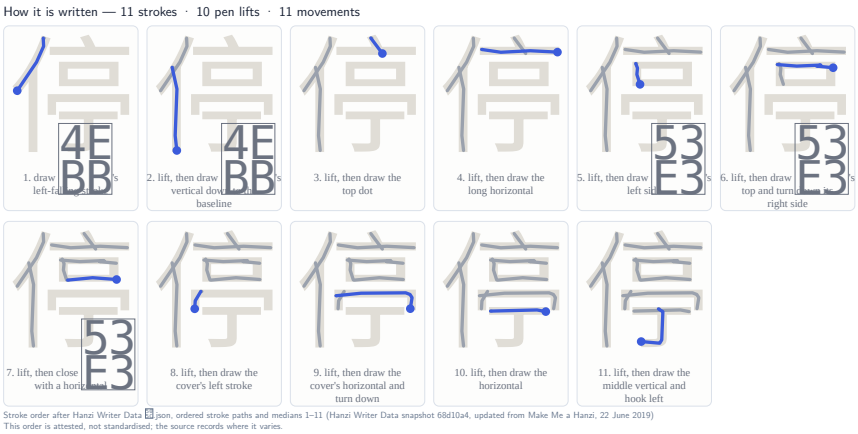
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tíngfēi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  你 高

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǐ*, *gāo*

Script — the person piece, then a tall right side



How 停 is written, stroke by stroke

停

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 亻, two strokes. The same two as in 你.

The right piece, nine strokes. A dot and a bar, then a small 口, three strokes: the top of 高. Under them a short stroke down and a bar that turns down and hooks: a lid. Then a bar across, and a vertical down the middle that hooks to the left at the foot.

2 + 9 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 停, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 停 have? (**Two.**) Which comes first? (**亻, the person piece.**) How does the last stroke end? (**With a hook to the left.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 停, pinned stroke paths and medians.

418.5 bànlǐ — to deal with the paperwork; to go through a procedure

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the formalities, then the Mandarin for to be grounded.

You'll want to know: bànlǐ

bànlǐ — "to deal with the paperwork; to go through a procedure".

wǒmen qù nà jiā bīnguǎn bànlǐ rùzhù — We're going to that hotel to check in.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bànlǐ is built from *bàn* 'to see to' and *lǐ* 'to put in order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *beanH* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to prepare' and the second 'to manage'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bànlǐ*
- *Say it: bànlǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qù nà jiā bīnguǎn bànlǐ rùzhù* — We're going to that hotel to check in.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the formalities, then the Mandarin for to be grounded, then say *bànlǐ* again

Before you move on

What does bànlǐ mean? ("To deal with the paperwork; to go through a procedure".) Say it once more.

418.6 chāozhòng — overweight; over the weight limit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be grounded, then the Mandarin for to deal with the paperwork.

You'll want to know: chāozhòng

chāozhòng — "overweight; over the weight limit".

nǐ de xiāngzi chāozhòng le — Your suitcase is overweight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chāozhòng is built from *chāo* 'to go beyond' and 重 'heavy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trhjew* and *drjowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to leap'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāozhòng*
- *Say it: chāozhòng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de xiāngzi chāozhòng le* — Your suitcase is overweight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be grounded, then the Mandarin for to deal with the paperwork, then say *chāozhòng* again

Before you move on

What does chāozhòng mean? ("Overweight; over the weight limit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 419

Arrivals

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can meet someone off a plane, change money, and say a flight is international or domestic.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 419: I can meet someone off a plane, change money, and say a flight is international or domestic.*

419.1 jiējī — to meet someone off a plane

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to deal with the paperwork, then the Mandarin for over the weight limit.

You'll want to know: jiējī

jiējī — "to meet someone off a plane".

> *míngtiān wǒ zuò chūzūchē qù jīchǎng jiējī* — Tomorrow I'm taking a taxi to the airport to meet someone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiējī is built from *jiē* 'to meet' and 机 'a plane', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjep* and *kj+j* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to join' and 'to meet'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiējī*
- *Say it: jiējī*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǒ zuò chūzūchē qù jīchǎng jiējī* — Tomorrow I'm taking a taxi to the airport to meet someone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to deal with the paperwork, then the Mandarin for over the weight limit, then say *jiējī* again

Before you move on

What does jiējī mean? ("To meet someone off a plane".) Say it once more.

419.2 duìhuàn — to exchange money

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for over the weight limit, then the Mandarin for to meet someone off a plane.

You'll want to know: duìhuàn

duìhuàn — "to exchange money".

wǒ zài jīchǎng duìhuàn le yìxiē qián — I changed some money at the airport.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duìhuàn is built from *duì* and *huàn* 'to exchange', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dwajH* and *hwanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as one of the eight trigrams and 'to please', and the second 'to exchange'; the sense 'to exchange' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: duìhuàn*
- *Say it: duìhuàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài jīchǎng duìhuàn le yìxiē qián* — I changed some money at the airport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for over the weight limit, then the Mandarin for to meet someone off a plane, then say *duìhuàn* again

Before you move on

What does duìhuàn mean? ("To exchange money".) Say it once more.

419.3 wàibì — foreign currency

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to meet someone off a plane, then the Mandarin for to exchange money.

You'll want to know: wàibì

wàibì — "foreign currency".

zhèr kěyǐ huàn wàibì — You can change foreign money here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàibì is built from 外 'outside' and *bì* 'money', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *bjiejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as gifts of silk.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàibì*
- *Say it: wàibì*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr kěyǐ huàn wàibì* — You can change foreign money here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to meet someone off a plane, then the Mandarin for to exchange money, then say *wàibì* again

Before you move on

What does wàibì mean? ("Foreign currency".) Say it once more.

419.4 guójì — international

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to exchange money, then the Mandarin for foreign currency.

You'll want to know: guójì

guójì — "international".

qù guójì hángzhànlóu zěnme zǒu — How do I get to the international terminal?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guójì is built from 国 'a country' and *jì* 'an edge, a meeting', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *tsjejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a border' and 'to meet'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: guójì*
- *Say it: guójì*, once more
- *Say it: qù guójì hángzhànlóu zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the international terminal?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to exchange money, then the Mandarin for foreign currency, then say *guójì* again

Before you move on

What does guójì mean? ("International".) Say it once more.

419.5 guónèi — domestic (inside the country)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for foreign currency, then the Mandarin for international.

You'll want to know: guónèi

guónèi — "domestic (inside the country)".

guónèi hángbān hěn piányi — Domestic flights are cheap.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guónèi is built from 国 'a country' and *nèi* 'inside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *nwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to go in'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: guónèi*
- *Say it: guónèi*, once more
- *Say it: guónèi hángbān hěn piányi* — Domestic flights are cheap.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for foreign currency, then the Mandarin for international, then say *guónèi* again

Before you move on

What does guónèi mean? ("Domestic (inside the country)".) Say it once more.

419.6 Looking back: from In the Cabin to Arrivals

Say the Mandarin for a flight attendant and next to the window.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a flight attendant, next to the window, economy class, to get airsick, a seat belt
- *Say it:* an airport terminal building, to check in a suitcase, a boarding pass, the security check at an airport, a departure gate
- *Say it:* to be held up, the measure word for a rainstorm, to miss a flight, to change planes on the way, flying (of an aircraft)
- *Say it:* customs at the border, to enter a country, to leave a country, to declare goods at customs, duty-free
- *Say it:* to check in for a flight, the formalities, to be grounded, to deal with the paperwork, over the weight limit
- *Say it:* to meet someone off a plane, to exchange money, foreign currency, international, inside the country
- *Read it:* 场 停 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A flight attendant? (*chéngwùyuán.*) Next to the window? (*kàochuāng.*) Economy class? (*jīngjìcāng.*) To get airsick? (*yùnjī.*) A seat belt? (*ānquándài.*) An airport terminal building? (*hángzhànlóu.*) To check in a suitcase? (*tuōyùn.*) A boarding pass? (*dēngjīpái.*) The security check at an airport? (安检, *ānjiǎn.*) A departure gate? (*dēngjīkǒu.*) To be held up? (*yánwù.*) The measure word for a rainstorm? (场, *chǎng.*) To miss a flight? (*wùjī.*) To change planes on the way? (*zhuǎnjī.*) Flying (of an aircraft)? (*fēixíng.*) Customs at the border? (*hǎiguān.*) To enter a country? (*rùjìng.*) To leave a country? (*chūjìng.*) To declare goods at customs? (*shēnbào.*) Duty-free? (*miǎnshuì.*) To check in for a flight? (*zhíjī.*) The formalities? (*shǒuxù.*) To be grounded? (停飞, *tíngfēi.*) To deal with the paperwork? (*bànlǐ.*) Over the weight limit? (*chāozhòng.*) To meet someone off a plane? (*jiējī.*) To exchange money? (*duìhuàn.*) Foreign currency? (*wàibì.*) International? (*guójì.*) Inside the country? (*guónèi.*)

Chapter 420

Parking

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a driving licence, traffic lanes, parking spaces, reversing and breaking the rules.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 420: I can talk about a driving licence, traffic lanes, parking spaces, reversing and breaking the rules.*

420.1 jiàzhào — driving licence

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for international, then the Mandarin for inside the country.

You'll want to know: jiàzhào

jiàzhào — "driving licence".

> *wǒ de jiàzhào bú jiàn le* — My driving licence has gone missing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàzhào is built from *jià* 'to drive' and *zhào*, short for a word for a licence; both are inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaeH* and *tsyewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to drive a team' and the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàzhào*
- *Say it: jiàzhào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de jiàzhào bú jiàn le* — My driving licence has gone missing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for international, then the Mandarin for inside the country, then say *jiàzhào* again

Before you move on

What does jiàzhào mean? ("Driving licence".) Say it once more.

420.2 车道 (chēdào) — traffic lane

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for inside the country, then the Mandarin for a driving licence.

You'll want to know: 车道

车道 — *chēdào* — "traffic lane".

wǎng yòubian de chēdào kāi — Move over into the right-hand lane.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

车道 (*chēdào*) is built from 车 'vehicle' and 道 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhae* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a road' and 'reason'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēdào*
- *Say it: chēdào*, once more
- *Say it: wǎng yòubian de chēdào kāi* — Move over into the right-hand lane.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for inside the country, then the Mandarin for a driving licence, then say *chēdào* again

Before you move on

What does 车道 mean? ("Traffic lane".) Say it once more.

420.3 chēwèi — parking space

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a driving licence, then the Mandarin for a traffic lane.

You'll want to know: chēwèi

chēwèi — "parking space".

wǒ zài tíngchēchǎng zhǎo bu dào chēwèi — I can't find a space in the car park.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chēwèi is built from 车 'vehicle' and *wèi* 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhae* and *hwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēwèi*
- *Say it: chēwèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài tíngchēchǎng zhǎo bu dào chēwèi* — I can't find a space in the car park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a driving licence, then the Mandarin for a traffic lane, then say *chēwèi* again

Before you move on

What does chēwèi mean? ("Parking space".) Say it once more.

420.4 dàochē — to reverse the car; to back up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a traffic lane, then the Mandarin for a parking space.

You'll want to know: dàochē

dàochē — "to reverse the car; to back up".

tā zài tíngchēchǎng dàochē — He's reversing in the car park.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàochē is built from *dào* 'backwards' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tawH* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as hanging upside down.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàochē*
- *Say it: dàochē*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài tíngchēchǎng dàochē* — He's reversing in the car park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a traffic lane, then the Mandarin for a parking space, then say *dàochē* again

Before you move on

What does dàochē mean? ("To reverse the car; to back up".) Say it once more.

420.5 wéizhāng — to break the traffic rules

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a parking space, then the Mandarin for to reverse the car.

You'll want to know: wéizhāng

wéizhāng — "to break the traffic rules".

zhèr bù néng tíngchē tíng le jiù wéizhāng — You can't park here: if you do, you're breaking the rules.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wéizhāng is built from *wéi* 'to go against' and *zhāng* 'a rule', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjw+j* and *tsyang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn your back on' and the second as a section of writing; the sense 'a rule' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: wéizhāng*
- *Say it: wéizhāng*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr bù néng tíngchē tíng le jiù wéizhāng* — You can't park here: if you do, you're breaking the rules.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a parking space, then the Mandarin for to reverse the car, then say *wéizhāng* again

Before you move on

What does wéizhāng mean? ("To break the traffic rules".) Say it once more.

Chapter 421

On the Expressway

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about main roads and the expressway, the speed of a car, toll gates and speeding.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 421: I can talk about main roads and the expressway, the speed of a car, toll gates and speeding.*

421.1 公路 (gōnglù) — highway; main road

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to reverse the car, then the Mandarin for to break the traffic rules.

You'll want to know: 公路

公路 — *gōnglù* — "highway; main road".

> *zhè tiáo gōnglù hěn cháng* — This main road is very long.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

公路 (*gōnglù*) is built from 公 'public' and 路 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōnglù*
- *Say it: gōnglù*, once more
- *Say it: zhè tiáo gōnglù hěn cháng* — This main road is very long.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to reverse the car, then the Mandarin for to break the traffic rules, then say *gōnglù* again

Before you move on

What does 公路 mean? ("Highway; main road".) Say it once more.

421.2 高速 (gāosù) — expressway

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to break the traffic rules, then the Mandarin for a main road between towns.

You'll want to know: 高速

高速 — *gāosù* — "expressway".

去高速怎么走 *qù gāosù zěnme zǒu* — How do I get onto the expressway?

The new character, in pieces: 速 — ten strokes in two pieces: the right piece first, seven strokes, a bar, a small 口, a long vertical down through them, a stroke falling to the left and a dot; then the walking piece of 这 under it, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

高速 (*gāosù*) is built from 高 'high' and 速 'speed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *suwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'swift'; it is a short form of a longer name, the high-speed road.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāosù*
- *Say it: gāosù*, once more
- *Say it: qù gāosù zěnme zǒu* — How do I get onto the expressway?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to break the traffic rules, then the Mandarin for a main road between towns, then say *gāosù* again

Before you move on

What does 高速 mean? (“Expressway”.) Say it once more.

421.3 速 — a bundle, then the walking piece

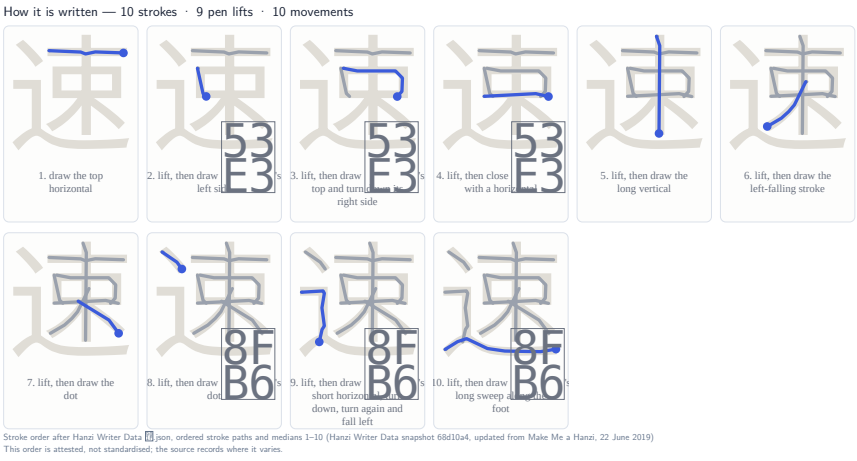
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gāosù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  这 高

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhè*, *gāo*

Script — a bundle, then the walking piece



How 速 is written, stroke by stroke

速

Two pieces, and the walking piece comes last. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The upper piece, seven strokes. A bar across the top. A small 口 under it, three strokes. A long vertical down through the bar and 口. Then a stroke falling to the left from the vertical and a dot to the right, as at the foot of the tree piece.

The walking piece, three strokes, as in 这: a dot, a stroke that zigzags down, then a long sweep along the foot.

7 + 3 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 速, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 速? (**Ten.**) What is written near the top? (**A small 口.**) Which piece comes last? (**The walking piece.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 速, pinned stroke paths and medians.

421.4 车速 (chēsù) — speed of a vehicle

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a main road between towns, then the Mandarin for the expressway.

You'll want to know: 车速

车速 — *chēsù* — "speed of a vehicle".

高速的车速很快 *gāosù de chēsù hěn kuài* — Cars go fast on the expressway.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

车速 (*chēsù*) is built from 车 'vehicle' and 速 'speed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhae* and *suwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēsù*
- *Say it: chēsù*, once more
- *Say it: gāosù de chēsù hěn kuài* — Cars go fast on the expressway.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a main road between towns, then the Mandarin for the expressway, then say *chēsù* again

Before you move on

What does 车速 mean? ("Speed of a vehicle".) Say it once more.

421.5 shōufèizhàn — toll gate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the expressway, then the Mandarin for the speed of a vehicle.

You'll want to know: shōufèizhàn

shōufèizhàn — "toll gate".

wǎng qián kāi jiù shì shōufèizhàn — Drive straight on and you come to the toll gate.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōufèizhàn is built from *shōu* 'to collect', *fèi* 'a fee' and 站 'a station', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw*, *phj+jH* and *treamH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to gather in'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōufèizhàn*
- *Say it: shōufèizhàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǎng qián kāi jiù shì shōufèizhàn* — Drive straight on and you come to the toll gate.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the expressway, then the Mandarin for the speed of a vehicle, then say *shōufèizhàn* again

Before you move on

What does shōufèizhàn mean? ("Toll gate".) Say it once more.

421.6 chāosù — to break the speed limit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the speed of a vehicle, then the Mandarin for a toll gate.

You'll want to know: chāosù

chāosù — "to break the speed limit".

nǐ kāi de tài kuài le chāosù le — You're driving too fast: you're over the limit.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chāosù is built from *chāo* 'to go beyond' and 速 'speed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trhjew* and *suwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to leap'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāosù*
- *Say it: chāosù*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ kāi de tài kuài le chāosù le* — You're driving too fast: you're over the limit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the speed of a vehicle, then the Mandarin for a toll gate, then say *chāosù* again

Before you move on

What does chāosù mean? ("To break the speed limit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 422

Going North

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use a satnav, name the northeast and the northwest, say we are heading north and take a fast bus.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 422: I can use a satnav, name the northeast and the northwest, say we are heading north and take a fast bus.*

422.1 dǎoháng — to navigate by satnav

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a toll gate, then the Mandarin for to break the speed limit.

You'll want to know: dǎoháng

dǎoháng — "to navigate by satnav".

> *wǒ yòng shǒujī dǎoháng zhǎodào le nà jiā fàndiàn* — I found the way to that restaurant with my phone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎoháng is built from *dǎo* 'to lead' and *háng* 'to sail', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dawH* and *hang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to lead' and the second 'a boat'.

dawH would regularly give dào: the falling-rising tone of dǎo is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎoháng*
- *Say it: dǎoháng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yòng shǒujī dǎoháng zhǎodào le nà jiā fàndiàn* — I found the way to that restaurant with my phone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a toll gate, then the Mandarin for to break the speed limit, then say *dǎoháng* again

Before you move on

What does dǎoháng mean? ("To navigate by satnav".) Say it once more.

422.2 东北 (dōngběi) — northeast; the Northeast (of China)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to break the speed limit, then the Mandarin for to navigate by satnav.

You'll want to know: 东北

东北 — *dōngběi* — "northeast; the Northeast (of China)".

火车进入了东北 *huǒchē jìnrù le dōngběi* — The train has come into the northeast of China.

The new character, in pieces: 北 — five strokes in two halves: on the left a vertical, a short bar into it from the left and a bar rising to the right at its foot; on the right a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

东北 (*dōngběi*) is built from 东 'east' and 北 'north', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tuwng* and *pok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'north' and 'to flee'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōngběi*
- *Say it: dōngběi*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchē jìnrù le dōngběi* — The train has come into the northeast of China.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to break the speed limit, then the Mandarin for to navigate by satnav, then say *dōngběi* again

Before you move on

What does 东北 mean? ("Northeast; the Northeast (of China)".) Say it once more.

422.3 北 — two halves back to back

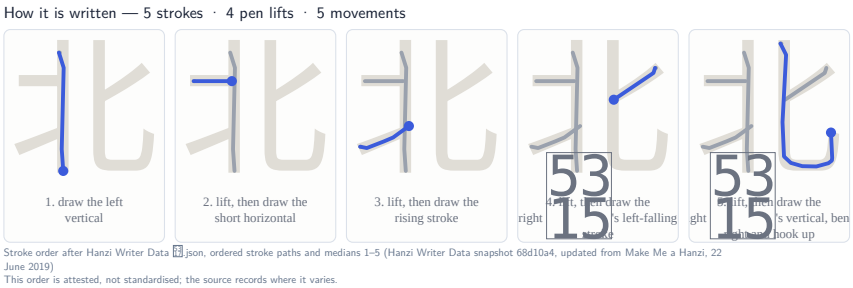
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dōngběi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  比 东

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bǐ*, *dōng*

Script — two halves back to back



How 北 is written, stroke by stroke

北

Two halves, left before right.

The left half, three strokes. A vertical. A short bar from the left into it. Then a bar rising to the right into its foot, from the left.

The right half, two strokes, as on the right of 比: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical that bends to the right along the foot and hooks up.

3 + 2 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 北, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 北? (**Five.**) What is the right half? (**The right half of 比.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 北, pinned stroke paths and medians.

422.4 西北 (xīběi) — northwest; the Northwest (of China)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to navigate by satnav, then the Mandarin for the northeast.

You'll want to know: 西北

西北 — *xīběi* — "northwest; the Northwest (of China)".

风从西北来 *fēng cóng xīběi lái* — The wind is coming from the northwest.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

西北 (*xīběi*) is built from 西 'west' and 北 'north', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sej* and *pok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīběi*
- *Say it: xīběi*, once more
- *Say it: fēng cóng xīběi lái* — The wind is coming from the northwest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to navigate by satnav, then the Mandarin for the northeast, then say *xīběi* again

Before you move on

What does 西北 mean? ("Northwest; the Northwest (of China)".) Say it once more.

422.5 北上 (běishàng) — to go north; to head up north

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the northeast, then the Mandarin for the northwest.

You'll want to know: 北上

北上 — *běishàng* — "to go north; to head up north".

明天我们坐飞机北上 *míngtiān wǒmen zuò fēijī běishàng* — Tomorrow we fly north.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

北上 (*běishàng*) is built from 北 'north' and 上 'to go up', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pok* and *dzyangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to climb'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: běishàng*
- *Say it: běishàng*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǒmen zuò fēijī běishàng* — Tomorrow we fly north.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the northeast, then the Mandarin for the northwest, then say *běishàng* again

Before you move on

What does 北上 mean? ("To go north; to head up north".) Say it once more.

422.6 快速 (kuàisù) — rapid; high-speed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the northwest, then the Mandarin for to head up north.

You'll want to know: 快速

快速 — *kuàisù* — "rapid; high-speed".

我们坐快速公交去机场 *wǒmen zuò kuàisù gōngjiāo qù jīchǎng* — We take the rapid bus to the airport.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

快速 (*kuàisù*) is built from 快 'fast' and 速 'swift', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khwaejH* and *suwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuàisù*
- *Say it: kuàisù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò kuàisù gōngjiāo qù jīchǎng* — We take the rapid bus to the airport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the northwest, then the Mandarin for to head up north, then say *kuàisù* again

Before you move on

What does 快速 mean? ("Rapid; high-speed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 423

Going South

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how the roads are, name the southeast and southwest, say we are heading south and compare.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 423: I can ask how the roads are, name the southeast and southwest, say we are heading south and compare.*

423.1 lùkuàng — road conditions

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to head up north, then the Mandarin for high-speed.

You'll want to know: lùkuàng

lùkuàng — "road conditions".

> *lùkuàng bù hǎo dehuà wǒmen zuò dìtiě qù* — If the roads are bad, we'll take the metro.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lùkuàng is built from 路 'a road' and *kuàng* 'a state of things', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luH* and *xjwangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to compare'; the sense 'state of things' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùkuàng*
- *Say it: lùkuàng*, once more
- *Say it: lùkuàng bù hǎo dehuà wǒmen zuò dìtiě qù* — If the roads are bad, we'll take the metro.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to head up north, then the Mandarin for high-speed, then say *lùkuàng* again

Before you move on

What does lùkuàng mean? ("Road conditions".) Say it once more.

423.2 东南 (dōngnán) — southeast

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for high-speed, then the Mandarin for road conditions.

You'll want to know: 东南

东南 — *dōngnán* — "southeast".

huǒchēzhàn zài jīchǎng de dōngnán fāngxiàng — The railway station is southeast of the airport.

The new character, in pieces: 南 — nine strokes: 十 on top; under it a frame open at the foot, a vertical down the left and a bar that turns down the right side and hooks; inside it a dot and a short stroke falling to the left, two bars, and a vertical down through them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

东南 (*dōngnán*) is built from 东 'east' and 南 'south', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tuwng* and *nom* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the second as the direction of fire.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dōngnán*
- *Say it: dōngnán*, once more
- *Say it: huǒchēzhàn zài jīchǎng de dōngnán fāngxiàng* — The railway station is southeast of the airport.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for high-speed, then the Mandarin for road conditions, then say *dōngnán* again

Before you move on

What does 东南 mean? ("Southeast".) Say it once more.

423.3 南 — 十 over a frame

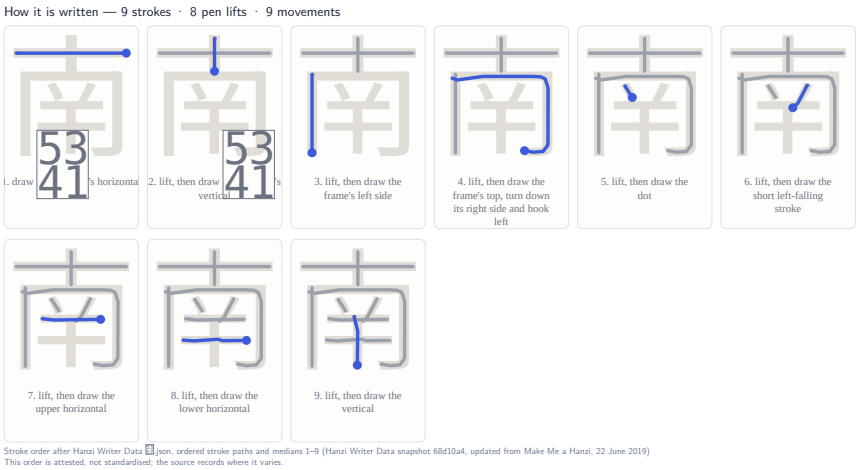
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dōngnán* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  十 东

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shí*, *dōng*

Script — 十 over a frame



How 南 *is written, stroke by stroke*

南

Two pieces, top to bottom.

The top piece, 十, two strokes. A short bar, then a vertical down through it.

The frame, two strokes. A vertical down the left. Then a bar across that turns down the right side and hooks to the left at the foot: the frame is open at the bottom.

Inside, five strokes. A dot and a short stroke falling to the left, side by side. Two bars, one under the other. Then a vertical from the upper bar down through the lower one.

$2 + 2 + 5 =$ nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 南, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 南? (**Nine.**) What sits on top? (十.) Is the frame closed at the foot? (**No, it is open.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 南, pinned stroke paths and medians.

423.4 西南 (xīnán) — southwest; the Southwest (of China)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for road conditions, then the Mandarin for the southeast.

You'll want to know: 西南

西南 — *xīnán* — "southwest; the Southwest (of China)".

wǒmen wǎng xīnán kāi — We're driving southwest.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

西南 (*xīnán*) is built from 西 'west' and 南 'south', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sej* and *nom* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnán*
- *Say it: xīnán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen wǎng xīnán kāi* — We're driving southwest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for road conditions, then the Mandarin for the southeast, then say *xīnán* again

Before you move on

What does 西南 mean? ("Southwest; the Southwest (of China)".) Say it once more.

423.5 南下 (nánxià) — to go south; to head down south

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the southeast, then the Mandarin for the southwest.

You'll want to know: 南下

南下 — *nánxià* — "to go south; to head down south".

下个月我们开车南下 *xià ge yuè wǒmen kāichē nánxià* — Next month we're driving south.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

南下 (*nánxià*) is built from 南 'south' and 下 'to go down', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nom* and *haeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'low' and 'to come down'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánxià*
- *Say it: nánxià*, once more
- *Say it: xià ge yuè wǒmen kāichē nánxià* — Next month we're driving south.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the southeast, then the Mandarin for the southwest, then say *nánxià* again

Before you move on

What does 南下 mean? (“To go south; to head down south”.) Say it once more.

423.6 南北 (nánběi) — north and south

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the southwest, then the Mandarin for to head down south.

You’ll want to know: 南北

南北 — *nánběi* — “north and south”.

Zhōngguó de nánběi hěn bù yíyàng — The north and the south of China are very different.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

南北 (*nánběi*) is built from 南 ’south’ and 北 ’north’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nom* and *pok* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription).

What you’ve built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánběi*
- *Say it: nánběi*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngguó de nánběi hěn bù yíyàng* — The north and the south of China are very different.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the southwest, then the Mandarin for to head down south, then say *nánběi* again

Before you move on

What does 南北 mean? (“North and south”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 424

On the Road

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about tunnels, turning round, road signs, speed per hour and stopping halfway.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 424: I can talk about tunnels, turning round, road signs, speed per hour and stopping halfway.*

424.1 suìdào — tunnel

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to head down south, then the Mandarin for north and south.

You'll want to know: suìdào

suìdào — "tunnel".

> *qiánbian yǒu yì tiáo suìdào* — There's a tunnel up ahead.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

suìdào is built from *suì* 'a passage' and *dào* 'a way', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zwijH* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the passage into a tomb and the second 'a road'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: suìdào*
- *Say it: suìdào*, once more
- *Say it: qiánbian yǒu yì tiáo suìdào* — There's a tunnel up ahead.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to head down south, then the Mandarin for north and south, then say *suìdào* again

Before you move on

What does suìdào mean? ("Tunnel".) Say it once more.

424.2 diàotóu — to turn round (in a car); to make a U-turn

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for north and south, then the Mandarin for a tunnel through a hill.

You'll want to know: diàotóu

diàotóu — "to turn round (in a car); to make a U-turn".

zhèr bù néng diàotóu wǎng qián kāi — You can't turn round here: drive on.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

diàotóu is built from *diào* 'to turn' and 头 'the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dewH* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to shake'; the sense 'to turn' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: diàotóu*
- *Say it: diàotóu*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr bù néng diàotóu wǎng qián kāi* — You can't turn round here: drive on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for north and south, then the Mandarin for a tunnel through a hill, then say *diàotóu* again

Before you move on

What does diàotóu mean? ("To turn round (in a car); to make a U-turn".) Say it once more.

424.3 lùbiāo — road sign

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tunnel through a hill, then the Mandarin for to make a U-turn.

You'll want to know: lùbiāo

lùbiāo — "road sign".

lùbiāo shuō wǎng qián zǒu — The sign says go straight on.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lùbiāo is built from 路 'a road' and *biāo* 'a mark', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luH* and *pjiew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the tip of a tree and 'to raise'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùbiāo*
- *Say it: lùbiāo*, once more
- *Say it: lùbiāo shuō wǎng qián zǒu* — The sign says go straight on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tunnel through a hill, then the Mandarin for to make a U-turn, then say *lùbiāo* again

Before you move on

What does lùbiāo mean? ("Road sign".) Say it once more.

424.4 时速 (shísù) — speed per hour

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a U-turn, then the Mandarin for a road sign.

You'll want to know: 时速

时速 — *shísù* — "speed per hour".

我们的时速是一百公里 *wǒmen de shísù shì yìbǎi gōnglǐ* — We're doing a hundred kilometres an hour.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

时速 (*shísù*) is built from 时 'an hour' and 速 'speed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyi* and *suwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shísù*
- *Say it: shísù*, once more

- *Say it: wǒmen de shísù shì yìbǎi gōnglǐ* — We're doing a hundred kilometres an hour.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a U-turn, then the Mandarin for a road sign, then say *shísù* again

Before you move on

What does 时速 mean? ("Speed per hour".) Say it once more.

424.5 半路 (bànlù) — halfway; on the way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a road sign, then the Mandarin for speed per hour.

You'll want to know: 半路

半路 — *bànlù* — "halfway; on the way".

我们在半路停了车 *wǒmen zài bànlù tíng le chē* — We stopped the car on the way.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

半路 (*bànlù*) is built from 半 'half' and 路 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *panH* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bànlù*
- *Say it: bànlù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài bànlù tíng le chē* — We stopped the car on the way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a road sign, then the Mandarin for speed per hour, then say *bànlù* again

Before you move on

What does 半路 mean? ("Halfway; on the way".) Say it once more.

424.6 Looking back: from Parking to On the Road

Say the Mandarin for a driving licence and a traffic lane.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a driving licence, a traffic lane, a parking space, to reverse the car, to break the traffic rules
- *Say it:* a main road between towns, the expressway, the speed of a vehicle, a toll gate, to break the speed limit
- *Say it:* to navigate by satnav, the northeast, the northwest, to head up north, high-speed
- *Say it:* road conditions, the southeast, the southwest, to head down south, north and south
- *Say it:* a tunnel through a hill, to make a U-turn, a road sign, speed per hour, halfway
- *Read it:* 速 北 南 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A driving licence? (*jiàzhào.*) A traffic lane? (车道, *chēdào.*) A parking space? (*chēwèi.*) To reverse the car? (*dàochē.*) To break the traffic rules? (*wéizhāng.*) A main road between towns? (公路, *gōnglù.*) The expressway? (高速, *gāosù.*) The speed of a vehicle? (车速, *chēsù.*) A toll gate? (*shōufèizhàn.*) To break the speed limit? (*chāosù.*) To navigate by satnav? (*dǎoháng.*) The northeast? (东北, *dōngběi.*) The northwest? (西北, *xīběi.*) To head up north? (北上, *běishàng.*) High-speed? (快速, *kuàisù.*) Road conditions? (*lùkuàng.*) The southeast? (东南, *dōngnán.*) The southwest? (西南, *xīnán.*) To head down south? (南下, *nánxià.*) North and south? (南北, *nánběi.*) A tunnel through a hill? (*suìdào.*) To make a U-turn? (*diàotóu.*) A

road sign? (*lùbiāo.*) Speed per hour? (时速, *shísù.*) Halfway? (半路, *bànlù.*)

Chapter 425

The Hotel

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a place to stay, a big hotel, its guest rooms, the room card and the lobby.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 425: I can talk about a place to stay, a big hotel, its guest rooms, the room card and the lobby.*

425.1 zhùsù — accommodation; a place to stay

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for speed per hour, then the Mandarin for halfway.

You'll want to know: zhùsù

zhùsù — "accommodation; a place to stay".

> *zhèr de zhùsù hěn guì* — Accommodation is expensive here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhùsù is built from *zhù* 'to stay' and *sù* 'to lodge for the night', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjuH* and *sjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stop' and the second 'a lodging'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhùsù*
- *Say it: zhùsù*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de zhùsù hěn guì* — Accommodation is expensive here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for speed per hour, then the Mandarin for halfway, then say *zhùsù* again

Before you move on

What does zhùsù mean? ("Accommodation; a place to stay".) Say it once more.

425.2 酒店 (jiǔdiàn) — big hotel

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for halfway, then the Mandarin for a place to stay.

You'll want to know: 酒店

酒店 — *jiǔdiàn* — "big hotel".

这家酒店很大 *zhè jiā jiǔdiàn hěn dà* — This hotel is very big.

The new character, in pieces: **酒** — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left the water piece of **洗**, three strokes; on the right a bar on top, a frame, a short stroke falling to the left and a vertical bending right inside it, a short bar, and a bar closing the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

酒店 (*jiǔdiàn*) is built from **酒** 'wine' and **店** 'a shop, an inn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjuwX* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as wine and sweet wine; how the pair came to mean a big hotel is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǔdiàn*
- *Say it: jiǔdiàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā jiǔdiàn hěn dà* — This hotel is very big.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for halfway, then the Mandarin for a place to stay, then say *jiǔdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 酒店 mean? ("Big hotel".) Say it once more.

425.3 酒 — the water piece, then a jar

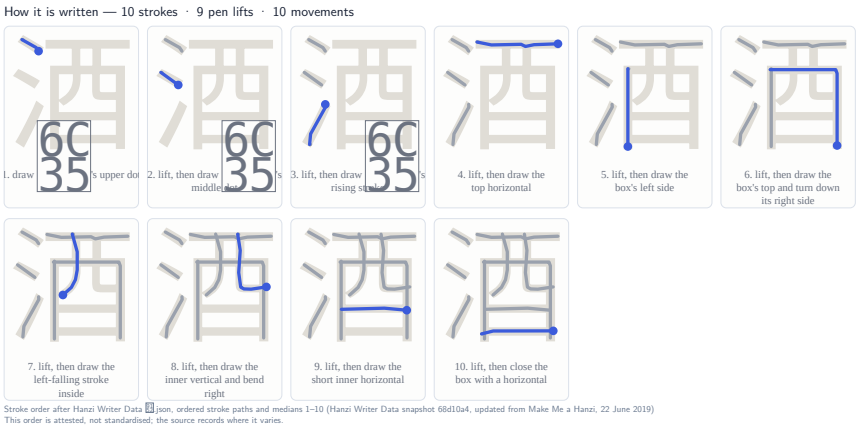
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiǔdiàn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  洗 店

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xǐ*, *diàn*

Script — the water piece, then a jar



How 酒 *is written, stroke by stroke*

酒

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the water piece, three strokes, as in 洗: two dots, then a stroke that rises to the right.

The right piece, seven strokes. A bar across the top. A vertical down the left, and a bar that turns down the right side. Inside, a short stroke falling to the left and a vertical that bends to the right at the foot. A short bar across them. Then a bar that closes the foot.

3 + 7 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 酒, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 酒? (**Ten.**) What is the left piece? (**The water piece, as in 洗.**) Is the frame closed at the foot? (**Yes, the last bar closes it.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 酒, pinned stroke paths and medians.

425.4 客房 (kèfáng) — hotel guest room

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a place to stay, then the Mandarin for a big hotel.

You'll want to know: 客房

客房 — *kèfáng* — "hotel guest room".

这家酒店有一百间客房 *zhè jiā jiǔdiàn yǒu yìbǎi jiān kèfáng* — This hotel has a hundred guest rooms.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

客房 (*kèfáng*) is built from **客** 'a guest' and **房** 'a room', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaek* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kèfáng*
- *Say it: kèfáng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā jiǔdiàn yǒu yìbǎi jiān kèfáng* — This hotel has a hundred guest rooms.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a place to stay, then the Mandarin for a big hotel, then say *kèfáng* again

Before you move on

What does **客房** mean? ("Hotel guest room".) Say it once more.

425.5 fángkǎ — room key card

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a big hotel, then the Mandarin for a hotel guest room.

You'll want to know: fángkǎ

fángkǎ — "room key card".

> *wǒ de fángkǎ bú jiàn le* — My room card has gone missing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fángkǎ is built from 房 'a room' and *kǎ* 'a card'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); *kǎ* is usually traced to English *card*.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fángkǎ*
- *Say it: fángkǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de fángkǎ bú jiàn le* — My room card has gone missing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a big hotel, then the Mandarin for a hotel guest room, then say *fángkǎ* again

Before you move on

What does fángkǎ mean? ("Room key card".) Say it once more.

425.6 dàtáng — hotel lobby

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hotel guest room, then the Mandarin for a room key card.

You'll want to know: dàtáng

dàtáng — "hotel lobby".

wǒ zài jiǔdiàn de dàtáng děng nǐ — I'll wait for you in the hotel lobby.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàtáng is built from 大 'big' and *táng* 'a hall', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH* and *dang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàtáng*
- *Say it: dàtáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài jiǔdiàn de dàtáng děng nǐ* — I'll wait for you in the hotel lobby.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hotel guest room, then the Mandarin for a room key card, then say *dàtáng* again

Before you move on

What does dàtáng mean? ("Hotel lobby".) Say it once more.

Chapter 426

Booking a Room

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for a standard room, hear that a hotel is full, find an inn, ask about stars and pay the bill.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 426: I can ask for a standard room, hear that a hotel is full, find an inn, ask about stars and pay the bill.*

426.1 dàchuángfáng — room with a double bed

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a room key card, then the Mandarin for the hotel lobby.

You'll want to know: dàchuángfáng

dàchuángfáng — "room with a double bed".

> *wǒmen yào yì jiān dàchuángfáng* — We'd like a double room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàchuángfáng is built from 大 'big', *chuáng* 'a bed' and 房 'a room', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *daH*, *dzrjang* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàchuángfáng*
- *Say it: dàchuángfáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yào yì jiān dàchuángfáng* — We'd like a double room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a room key card, then the Mandarin for the hotel lobby, then say *dàchuángfáng* again

Before you move on

What does dàchuángfáng mean? ("Room with a double bed".) Say it once more.

426.2 kèmǎn — fully booked; with no vacancies

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the hotel lobby, then the Mandarin for a room with a double bed.

You'll want to know: kèmǎn

kèmǎn — "fully booked; with no vacancies".

duìbuqǐ jīntiān kèmǎn le — Sorry, we're full tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kèmǎn is built from 客 'a guest' and *mǎn* 'full', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaek* and *manX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'full, filled'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kèmǎn*
- *Say it: kèmǎn*, once more
- *Say it: duìbuqǐ jīntiān kèmǎn le* — Sorry, we're full tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the hotel lobby, then the Mandarin for a room with a double bed, then say *kèmǎn* again

Before you move on

What does kèmǎn mean? ("Fully booked; with no vacancies".) Say it once more.

426.3 旅店 (lǚdiàn) — inn; small hotel

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a room with a double bed, then the Mandarin for fully booked.

You'll want to know: 旅店

旅店 — *lǚdiàn* — "inn; small hotel".

这家旅店很小 *zhè jiā lǚdiàn hěn xiǎo* — This inn is very small.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

旅店 (*lǚdiàn*) is built from 旅 'to travel' and 店 'an inn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljoX* and *temH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a body of troops, so the sense 'to travel' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǚdiàn*
- *Say it: lǚdiàn*, once more

- *Say it: zhè jiā lǚdiàn hěn xiǎo* — This inn is very small.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a room with a double bed, then the Mandarin for fully booked, then say *lǚdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 旅店 mean? ("Inn; small hotel".) Say it once more.

426.4 xīngjí — hotel star rating

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fully booked, then the Mandarin for a small inn.

You'll want to know: xīngjí

xīngjí — "hotel star rating".

zhè jiā jiǔdiàn de xīngjí hěn gāo — This hotel has a lot of stars.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīngjí is built from 星 'a star' and *jí* 'a rank', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *seng* and *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīngjí*
- *Say it: xīngjí*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā jiǔdiàn de xīngjí hěn gāo* — This hotel has a lot of stars.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fully booked, then the Mandarin for a small inn, then say *xīngjí* again

Before you move on

What does xīngjí mean? ("Hotel star rating".) Say it once more.

426.5 chāzuò — power socket

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a small inn, then the Mandarin for the hotel star rating.

You'll want to know: chāzuò

chāzuò — "power socket".

fángjiān lǐ de chāzuò zài nǎr — Where's the socket in the room?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chāzuò is built from *chā* 'to insert' and *zuò* 'a seat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrheap* and *dzwaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the seat of a bed.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāzuò*
- *Say it: chāzuò*, once more
- *Say it: fángjiān lǐ de chāzuò zài nǎr* — Where's the socket in the room?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a small inn, then the Mandarin for the hotel star rating, then say *chāzuò* again

Before you move on

What does chāzuò mean? ("Power socket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 427

Comings and Goings

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the room next door, traffic coming and going, the buffet, the sheets and a bus's route.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 427: I can talk about the room next door, traffic coming and going, the buffet, the sheets and a bus's route.*

427.1 gébì — next door

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the hotel star rating, then the Mandarin for a power socket.

You'll want to know: gébì

gébì — "next door".

> *wǒ zhù zài gébì* — I'm staying next door.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gébì is built from *gé* 'to separate' and *bì* 'a wall', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keak* and *pek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to block' and the second 'a wall'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gébì*
- *Say it: gébì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhù zài gébì* — I'm staying next door.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the hotel star rating, then the Mandarin for a power socket, then say *gébì* again

Before you move on

What does gébì mean? ("Next door".) Say it once more.

427.2 来往 (láiwǎng) — to come and go

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a power socket, then the Mandarin for right next door.

You'll want to know: 来往

来往 — *láiwǎng* — "to come and go".

路口来往的车很快你要小心 *lùkǒu láiwǎng de chē hěn kuài nǐ yào xiǎoxīn* — The cars coming and going at the junction are fast: be careful.

The new character, in pieces: 往 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left the left piece of 很, three strokes, two short strokes falling to the left and a vertical; on the right a dot, two bars, a vertical through them and a long bar at the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

来往 (*láiwǎng*) is built from 来 'to come' and 往 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *loj* and *hjwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to go'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: láiwǎng*
- *Say it: láiwǎng*, once more
- *Say it: lùkǒu láiwǎng de chē hěn kuài nǐ yào xiǎoxīn* — The cars coming and going at the junction are fast: be careful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a power socket, then the Mandarin for right next door, then say *láiwǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 来往 mean? ("To come and go".) Say it once more.

427.3 往 — the left piece of 很, then a dot over three bars

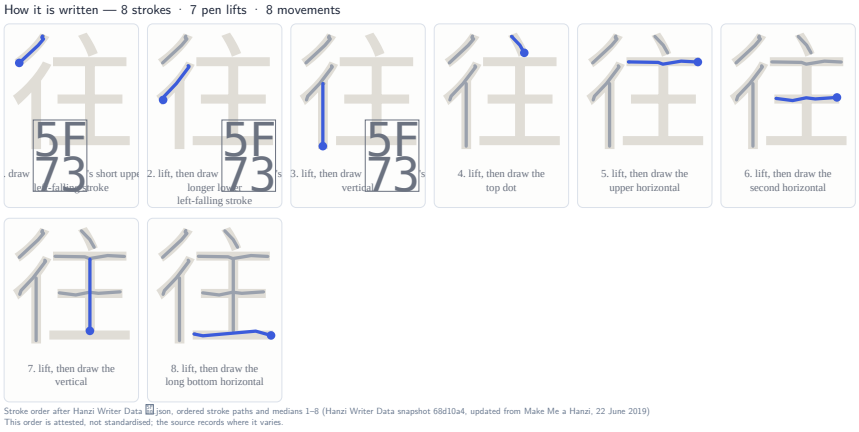
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *láiwǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  很 来

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hěn*, *lái*

Script — the left piece of 很, then a dot over three bars



How 往 *is written, stroke by stroke*

往

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes, as in 很: two short strokes falling to the left, one under the other, then a vertical down from the second.

The right piece, five strokes. A dot on top. A bar, then a second bar. A vertical down through them. Then a long bar across the foot.

3 + 5 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 往, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 往? (**Eight.**) What is the left piece? (**The left piece of 很.**) What closes the right piece at the foot? (**A long bar.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 往, pinned stroke paths and medians.

427.4 zìzhùcān — buffet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for right next door, then the Mandarin for to come and go.

You'll want to know: zìzhùcān

zìzhùcān — "buffet".

zhè jiā jiǔdiàn de zǎofàn shì zìzhùcān — Breakfast at this hotel is a buffet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zìzhùcān is built from *zì* 'oneself', *zhù* 'to help' and *cān* 'a meal', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH*, *dzrjoH* and *tshan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the third 'to swallow'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìzhùcān*
- *Say it: zìzhùcān*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā jiǔdiàn de zǎofàn shì zìzhùcān* — Breakfast at this hotel is a buffet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for right next door, then the Mandarin for to come and go, then say *zìzhùcān* again

Before you move on

What does zìzhùcān mean? ("Buffet".) Say it once more.

427.5 chuángdān — bed sheet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come and go, then the Mandarin for a buffet.

You'll want to know: chuángdān

chuángdān — "bed sheet".

wǒ xiǎng huàn chuángdān — I'd like the sheets changed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuángdān is built from *chuáng* 'a bed' and *dān* 'a single layer', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzrjang* and *tan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuángdān*
- *Say it: chuángdān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng huàn chuángdān* — I'd like the sheets changed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come and go, then the Mandarin for a buffet, then say *chuángdān* again

Before you move on

What does chuángdān mean? ("Bed sheet".) Say it once more.

427.6 开往 (kāiwǎng) — to be bound for a place

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a buffet, then the Mandarin for a bed sheet.

You'll want to know: 开往

开往 — *kāiwǎng* — "to be bound for a place".

开往机场的车在酒店门口 *kāiwǎng jīchǎng de chē zài jiǔdiàn ménkǒu* — The bus to the airport is at the hotel entrance.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开往 (*kāiwǎng*) is built from 开 'to drive off' and 往 'to go towards', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *hjwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to go'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāiwǎng*
- *Say it: kāiwǎng*, once more
- *Say it: kāiwǎng jīchǎng de chē zài jiǔdiàn ménkǒu* — The bus to the airport is at the hotel entrance.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a buffet, then the Mandarin for a bed sheet, then say *kāiwǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 开往 mean? ("To be bound for a place".) Say it once more.

Chapter 428

Moving On

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where a door leads, follow an announcement, and talk about the trip back, the plan and receipts.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 428: I can say where a door leads, follow an announcement, and talk about the trip back, the plan and receipts.*

428.1 通往 (tōngwǎng) — to lead to

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bed sheet, then the Mandarin for to be bound for a place.

You'll want to know: 通往

通往 — *tōngwǎng* — "to lead to".

> 这个门通往停车场 *zhège mén tōngwǎng tíngchēchǎng* — This door leads to the car park.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

通往 (*tōngwǎng*) is built from 通 'to go through' and 往 'to go towards', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thuwng* and *hjwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōngwǎng*
- *Say it: tōngwǎng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège mén tōngwǎng tíngchēchǎng* — This door leads to the car park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bed sheet, then the Mandarin for to be bound for a place, then say *tōngwǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 通往 mean? ("To lead to".) Say it once more.

428.2 前往 (qiánwǎng) — to set out for a place

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be bound for a place, then the Mandarin for to lead to a place.

You'll want to know: 前往

前往 — *qiánwǎng* — "to set out for a place".

前往机场的旅客请上车 *qiánwǎng jīchǎng de lǚkè qǐng shàng chē* — Passengers for the airport, please get on.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

前往 (*qiánwǎng*) is built from 前 'forward' and 往 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzen* and *hjwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'before'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiánwǎng*
- *Say it: qiánwǎng*, once more
- *Say it: qiánwǎng jīchǎng de lǚkè qǐng shàng chē* — Passengers for the airport, please get on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be bound for a place, then the Mandarin for to lead to a place, then say *qiánwǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 前往 mean? ("To set out for a place".) Say it once more.

428.3 huíchéng — return journey; the journey back

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lead to a place, then the Mandarin for to set out for a place.

You'll want to know: huíchéng

huíchéng — "return journey; the journey back".

huíchéng wǒmen zuò gāotiě — On the way back we're taking the fast train.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huíchéng is built from 回 'to go back' and *chéng* 'a stage of a journey', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *drjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a set period' and 'a rule'; the sense 'a stretch of road' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: huíchéng*
- *Say it: huíchéng*, once more
- *Say it: huíchéng wǒmen zuò gāotiě* — On the way back we're taking the fast train.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lead to a place, then the Mandarin for to set out for a place, then say *huíchéng* again

Before you move on

What does huíchéng mean? ("Return journey; the journey back".) Say it once more.

428.4 xíngchéng — itinerary; plan for a trip

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to set out for a place, then the Mandarin for the journey back.

You'll want to know: xíngchéng

xíngchéng — "itinerary; plan for a trip".

wǒ zhǎo bu dào wǒmen de xíngchéng le — I can't find our itinerary.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xíngchéng is built from *xíng* 'to go' and *chéng* 'a stage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeng* and *drjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xíngchéng*
- *Say it: xíngchéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhǎo bu dào wǒmen de xíngchéng le* — I can't find our itinerary.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to set out for a place, then the Mandarin for the journey back, then say *xíngchéng* again

Before you move on

What does xíngchéng mean? ("Itinerary; plan for a trip".) Say it once more.

428.5 发票 (fāpiào) — official receipt

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the journey back, then the Mandarin for the plan for a trip.

You'll want to know: 发票

发票 — *fāpiào* — "official receipt".

我的发票不见了 *wǒ de fāpiào bú jiàn le* — My receipt has gone missing.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

发票 (*fāpiào*) is built from *fā* 'to send out' and 票 'a slip'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to start' and 'to send out'; no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāpiào*
- *Say it: fāpiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de fāpiào bú jiàn le* — My receipt has gone missing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the journey back, then the Mandarin for the plan for a trip, then say *fāpiào* again

Before you move on

What does 发票 mean? ("Official receipt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 429

Home Again

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the journey, give someone a lift on my way, get a lift, get about and count the costs.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 429: I can talk about the journey, give someone a lift on my way, get a lift, get about and count the costs.*

429.1 lǚtú — journey

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the plan for a trip, then the Mandarin for an official receipt.

You'll want to know: lǚtú

lǚtú — "journey".

> *lǚtú hěn cháng wǒmen dōu hěn lèi* — It was a long journey, and we're all tired.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǚtú is built from 旅 'to travel' and *tú* 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljoX* and *du* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first as a body of troops and the second 'a road'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǚtú*
- *Say it: lǚtú*, once more
- *Say it: lǚtú hěn cháng wǒmen dōu hěn lèi* — It was a long journey, and we're all tired.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the plan for a trip, then the Mandarin for an official receipt, then say *lǚtú* again

Before you move on

What does lǚtú mean? ("Journey".) Say it once more.

429.2 shùnlù — on one's way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an official receipt, then the Mandarin for the journey as a whole.

You'll want to know: shùnlù

shùnlù — "on one's way".

wǒ zhù zài nǐ jiā fùjìn shùnlù sòng nǐ qù jīchǎng — I live near you, so I'll drop you at the airport on my way.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shùnlù is built from *shùn* 'to follow' and 路 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zywinH* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to follow'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shùnlù*
- *Say it: shùnlù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhù zài nǐ jiā fùjìn shùnlù sòng nǐ qù jīchǎng* — I live near you, so I'll drop you at the airport on my way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an official receipt, then the Mandarin for the journey as a whole, then say *shùnlù* again

Before you move on

What does shùnlù mean? ("On one's way".) Say it once more.

429.3 dāchē — to get a lift

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the journey as a whole, then the Mandarin for on one's way.

You'll want to know: dāchē

dāchē — "to get a lift".

wǒmen dāchē huí jiā — We got a lift home.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dāchē is built from *dā* 'to join on' and 车 'vehicle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thap* and *tsyhae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first only as a word for touching, so the sense 'to ride along' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāchē*
- *Say it: dāchē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen dāchē huí jiā* — We got a lift home.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the journey as a whole, then the Mandarin for on one's way, then say *dāchē* again

Before you move on

What does dāchē mean? ("To get a lift".) Say it once more.

429.4 chūxíng — to get about; to go out on a journey

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for on one's way, then the Mandarin for to get a lift.

You'll want to know: chūxíng

chūxíng — "to get about; to go out on a journey".

xiàyǔ de shíhou chūxíng hěn bù fāngbiàn — When it rains, getting about is a real nuisance.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūxíng is built from 出 'to go out' and *xíng* 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *haeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūxíng*
- *Say it: chūxíng*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ de shíhou chūxíng hěn bù fāngbiàn* — When it rains, getting about is a real nuisance.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for on one's way, then the Mandarin for to get a lift, then say *chūxíng* again

Before you move on

What does chūxíng mean? ("To get about; to go out on a journey".) Say it once more.

429.5 lùfèi — travel costs; the cost of getting there

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get a lift, then the Mandarin for to go out on a journey.

You'll want to know: lùfèi

lùfèi — "travel costs; the cost of getting there".

zuò huǒchē qù Běijīng lùfèi shì duōshao — How much does it cost to get to Beijing by train?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lùfèi is built from 路 'a road' and *fèi* 'a cost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luH* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùfèi*
- *Say it: lùfèi*, once more
- *Say it: zuò huǒchē qù Běijīng lùfèi shì duōshao* — How much does it cost to get to Beijing by train?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get a lift, then the Mandarin for to go out on a journey, then say *lùfèi* again

Before you move on

What does lùfèi mean? ("Travel costs; the cost of getting there".) Say it once more.

429.6 Looking back: from The Hotel to Home Again

Say the Mandarin for a place to stay and a big hotel.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a place to stay, a big hotel, a hotel guest room, a room key card, the hotel lobby
- *Say it:* a room with a double bed, fully booked, a small inn, the hotel star rating, a power socket
- *Say it:* right next door, to come and go, a buffet, a bed sheet, to be bound for a place
- *Say it:* to lead to a place, to set out for a place, the journey back, the plan for a trip, an official receipt
- *Say it:* the journey as a whole, on one's way, to get a lift, to go out on a journey, the cost of getting there
- *Read it:* 酒 往 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A place to stay? (*zhùsù.*) A big hotel? (酒店, *jiǔdiàn.*) A hotel guest room? (客房, *kèfáng.*) A room key card? (*fángkǎ.*) The hotel lobby? (*dàtáng.*) A room with a double bed? (*dàchuángfáng.*) Fully booked? (*kèmǎn.*) A small inn? (旅店, *lǚdiàn.*) The hotel star rating? (*xīngjí.*) A power socket? (*chāzuò.*) Right next door? (*gébì.*) To come and go? (来往, *láiwǎng.*) A buffet? (*zìzhùcān.*) A bed sheet? (*chuángdān.*) To be bound for a place? (开往, *kāiwǎng.*) To lead to a place? (通往, *tōngwǎng.*) To set out for a place? (前往, *qiánwǎng.*) The journey back? (*huíchéng.*) The plan for a trip? (*xíngchéng.*) An official receipt? (发票, *fāpiào.*) The journey as a whole? (*lǚtú.*) On one's way? (*shùnlù.*) To get a lift? (*dāchē.*) To go out on a journey? (*chūxíng.*) The cost of getting there? (*lùfèi.*)

429.7 Home Again — once more

Say the Mandarin for the journey as a whole and on one's way.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the journey as a whole, on one's way, to get a lift, to go out on a journey, the cost of getting there

Before you move on

The journey as a whole? (*lǚtú.*) On one's way? (*shùnlù.*) To get a lift? (*dāchē.*) To go out on a journey? (*chūxíng.*) The cost of getting there? (*lùfèi.*)

Chapter 430

Seeing the Sights

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about going sightseeing, historic sites, a scenic area, a selfie and the busy season.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 430: I can talk about going sightseeing, historic sites, a scenic area, a selfie and the busy season.*

430.1 guānguāng — to go sightseeing

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get about, then the Mandarin for travel costs.

You'll want to know: guānguāng

guānguāng — "to go sightseeing".

> *wǒmen zhù zài zhè jiā jiǔdiàn měitiān qù guānguāng* — We're staying at this hotel and going sightseeing every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guānguāng is built from *guān* 'to view' and *guāng* 'light', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwan* and *kwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to view' and the second 'bright'. How the pair came to mean touring the sights is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānguāng*
- *Say it: guānguāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhù zài zhè jiā jiǔdiàn měitiān qù guānguāng* — We're staying at this hotel and going sightseeing every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get about, then the Mandarin for travel costs, then say *guānguāng* again

Before you move on

What does guānguāng mean? ("To go sightseeing".) Say it once more.

430.2 gǔjì — historic site

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for travel costs, then the Mandarin for to go sightseeing.

You'll want to know: gǔjì

gǔjì — "historic site".

wǒmen zuò gōngjiāo qù kàn gǔjì — We're taking the bus to visit the historic sites.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǔjì is built from *gǔ* 'ancient' and *jì* 'a trace', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *tsjek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'former' and the second 'a footprint'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔjì*
- *Say it: gǔjì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò gōngjiāo qù kàn gǔjì* — We're taking the bus to visit the historic sites.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for travel costs, then the Mandarin for to go sightseeing, then say *gǔjì* again

Before you move on

What does gǔjì mean? ("Historic site".) Say it once more.

430.3 jǐngqū — scenic area

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go sightseeing, then the Mandarin for a historic site.

You'll want to know: jǐngqū

jǐngqū — "scenic area".

zhège jǐngqū zǎoshang bā diǎn kāimén — This scenic area opens at eight in the morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǐngqū is built from *jǐng* 'a view' and *qū* 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaengX* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'bright' and 'great' and gives the second as the name of a marsh; the senses 'a view' and 'an area' are not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐngqū*
- *Say it: jǐngqū*, once more
- *Say it: zhège jǐngqū zǎoshang bā diǎn kāimén* — This scenic area opens at eight in the morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go sightseeing, then the Mandarin for a historic site, then say *jǐngqū* again

Before you move on

What does jǐngqū mean? ("Scenic area".) Say it once more.

430.4 zìpāi — to take a selfie

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a historic site, then the Mandarin for a scenic area.

You'll want to know: zìpāi

zìpāi — "to take a selfie".

tā zài jiǔdiàn de dàtáng zìpāi — She's taking a selfie in the hotel lobby.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zìpāi is built from *zì* 'oneself' and *pāi* 'to snap a picture', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *phaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'from' and the second 'to strike'; the sense 'to take a photo' is modern.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìpāi*
- *Say it: zìpāi*, once more
- *Say it: tā zài jiǔdiàn de dàtáng zìpāi* — She's taking a selfie in the hotel lobby.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a historic site, then the Mandarin for a scenic area, then say *zìpāi* again

Before you move on

What does zìpāi mean? ("To take a selfie".) Say it once more.

430.5 wàngjì — peak season; busy season

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a scenic area, then the Mandarin for to take a selfie.

You'll want to know: wàngjì

wàngjì — "peak season; busy season".

wàngjì de shíhou jiǔdiàn dōu kèmǎn le — In the peak season the hotels are all fully booked.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàngjì is built from *wàng* 'thriving' and *jì* 'a season', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwangH* and *kjwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a fine light and the second as the youngest of brothers; the senses 'thriving' and 'a season' are not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàngjì*
- *Say it: wàngjì*, once more
- *Say it: wàngjì de shíhou jiǔdiàn dōu kèmǎn le* — In the peak season the hotels are all fully booked.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a scenic area, then the Mandarin for to take a selfie, then say *wàngjì* again

Before you move on

What does wàngjì mean? ("Peak season; busy season".) Say it once more.

Chapter 431

A Spring Outing

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can follow a guide's commentary, go on a spring outing, take a pleasure boat, say there are many and pose for a group photo.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 431: I can follow a guide's commentary, go on a spring outing, take a pleasure boat, say there are many and pose for a group photo.*

431.1 解说 (jiěshuō) — to give a running commentary

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take a selfie, then the Mandarin for the peak season.

You'll want to know: 解说

解说 — *jiěshuō* — "to give a running commentary".

> *dǎoyóu zhèngzài gěi wǒmen jiěshuō* — The guide is giving us a commentary.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

解说 (*jiěshuō*) is built from **解** 'to explain' and **说** 'to speak', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keaX* and *sywet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to explain' and the

second 'to tell'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiěshuō*
- *Say it: jiěshuō*, once more
- *Say it: dǎoyóu zhèngzài gěi wǒmen jiěshuō* — The guide is giving us a commentary.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take a selfie, then the Mandarin for the peak season, then say *jiěshuō* again

Before you move on

What does 解说 mean? ("To give a running commentary".) Say it once more.

431.2 春游 (chūnyóu) — spring outing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the peak season, then the Mandarin for to give a running commentary.

You'll want to know: 春游

春游 — *chūnyóu* — "spring outing".

我们坐火车去春游 *wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù chūnyóu* — We're going on a spring outing by train.

The new character, in pieces: 游 — twelve strokes in three pieces: on the left the water piece of 洗, three strokes; in the middle a dot, a bar, a stroke that turns down and hooks, and a stroke falling to the left; on the right a short stroke falling to the left and a bar, with 子 under them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

春游 (*chūnyóu*) is built from 春 'spring' and 游 'to roam', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwin* and *yuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to float' and 'to let loose'; the sense 'to tour' is usually explained as a widening of it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūnyóu*
- *Say it: chūnyóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù chūnyóu* — We're going on a spring outing by train.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the peak season, then the Mandarin for to give a running commentary, then say *chūnyóu* again

Before you move on

What does 春游 mean? ("Spring outing".) Say it once more.

431.3 游 — the water piece, a middle piece, then 子

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chūnyóu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  洗 子

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xǐ*, *zǐ*

Script — the water piece, a middle piece, then 子

How 游 *is written, stroke by stroke*

游

Three pieces, left to right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the water piece, three strokes, as in 洗: two dots, then a stroke that rises to the right.

The middle piece, four strokes. A dot on top. A bar under it. Under the bar, a stroke that runs a little to the right, turns down and hooks to the left at the foot. Then a stroke falling to the left, from under the bar.

The right piece, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left and a bar, like a small roof. Under them 子 zǐ: a bar that turns down to the left, a vertical with a hook, and a bar across.

3 + 4 + 5 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 游, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 游 have? (**Three: three strokes, four and five.**) Which written character sits at the bottom right? (**子, three strokes.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 游, pinned stroke paths and medians.

431.4 游船 (yóuchuán) — pleasure boat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give a running commentary, then the Mandarin for a spring outing.

You'll want to know: 游船

游船 — *yóuchuán* — "pleasure boat".

wǒmen zuò yóuchuán qù hú duìmiàn — We're taking a pleasure boat across the lake.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

游船 (*yóuchuán*) is built from 游 'to roam' and 船 'a boat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóuchuán*
- *Say it: yóuchuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò yóuchuán qù hú duìmiàn* — We're taking a pleasure boat across the lake.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give a running commentary, then the Mandarin for a spring outing, then say *yóuchuán* again

Before you move on

What does 游船 mean? (“Pleasure boat”.) Say it once more.

431.5 多 (duō) — many; much; a lot of

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a spring outing, then the Mandarin for a pleasure boat.

You’ll want to know: 多

多 — *duō* — “many; much; a lot of”.

春天这儿的游客很多 *chūntiān zhèr de yóukè hěn duō* — In spring there are a lot of visitors here.

Before a noun it is usually 很多 hěn duō: 很多人 ’a lot of people’.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

多 (*duō*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *ta* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses it ’many’.

What you’ve built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: duō*
- *Say it: duō*, once more
- *Say it: chūntiān zhèr de yóukè hěn duō* — In spring there are a lot of visitors here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a spring outing, then the Mandarin for a pleasure boat, then say *duō* again

Before you move on

What does 多 mean? (“Many; much; a lot of”.) Say it once more.

431.6 héyǐng — to have a group photo taken; to pose for a group photo

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pleasure boat, then the Mandarin for many.

You'll want to know: héyǐng

héyǐng — "to have a group photo taken; to pose for a group photo".

wǒmen zài jiǔdiàn ménkǒu héyǐng — We're having a group photo taken outside the hotel.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

héyǐng is built from *hé* 'together' and *yǐng* 'a likeness', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hop* and *'jaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to join' and the second as a shape and its shadow; the sense 'a photograph' is modern.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: héyǐng*
- *Say it: héyǐng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài jiǔdiàn ménkǒu héyǐng* — We're having a group photo taken outside the hotel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pleasure boat, then the Mandarin for many, then say *héyǐng* again

Before you move on

What does héyǐng mean? ("To have a group photo taken; to pose for a group photo".) Say it once more.

Chapter 432

Busy and Quiet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say there are few visitors, talk about the off season and public holidays, buy a full-price ticket and hear that a place is closed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 432: I can say there are few visitors, talk about the off season and public holidays, buy a full-price ticket and hear that a place is closed.*

432.1 少 (shǎo) — few; not much

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for many, then the Mandarin for to pose for a group photo.

You'll want to know: 少

少 — *shǎo* — "few; not much".

> 今年这家酒店的客人很少 *jīnnián zhè jiā jiǔdiàn de kèrén hěn shǎo* — This hotel has had very few guests this year.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

少 (*shǎo*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *syewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'not many'. The dictionary lists a second reading, *syewH*, glossed 'young': the shào of 少年.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǎo*
- *Say it: shǎo*, once more
- *Say it: jīnnián zhè jiā jiǔdiàn de kèrén hěn shǎo* — This hotel has had very few guests this year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for many, then the Mandarin for to pose for a group photo, then say *shǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 少 mean? ("Few; not much".) Say it once more.

432.2 dànjì — off season; quiet season

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pose for a group photo, then the Mandarin for few.

You'll want to know: dànjì

dànjì — "off season; quiet season".

dànjì de shíhou yóukè hěn shǎo — In the off season there are very few visitors.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dànjì is built from *dàn* 'thin, slack' and *jì* 'a season', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *damX* and *kjwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a thin taste and the second as the youngest of brothers; the sense 'a season' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dànjì*
- *Say it: dànjì*, once more
- *Say it: dànjì de shíhou yóukè hěn shǎo* — In the off season there are very few visitors.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pose for a group photo, then the Mandarin for few, then say *dànjì* again

Before you move on

What does dànjì mean? ("Off season; quiet season".) Say it once more.

432.3 节假日 (jiéjiàrì) — public holiday

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for few, then the Mandarin for the off season.

You'll want to know: 节假日

节假日 — *jiéjiàrì* — "public holiday".

jiéjiàrì de shíhou hěn duō rén zuò huǒchē qù hǎibiān — On public holidays lots of people take the train to the seaside.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

节假日 (*jiéjiàrì*) is built from 节 'a festival', 假 'leave' and 日 'a day', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tset*, *kaeH* and *nyit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the joint of a bamboo stem and the second 'to borrow' and 'leave'; the sense 'a festival' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiéjiàrì*
- *Say it: jiéjiàrì*, once more
- *Say it: jiéjiàrì de shíhou hěn duō rén zuò huǒchē qù hǎibiān* — On public holidays lots of people take the train to the seaside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for few, then the Mandarin for the off season, then say *jiéjiàrì* again

Before you move on

What does 节假日 mean? ("Public holiday".) Say it once more.

432.4 全票 (quánpiào) — full-price ticket

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the off season, then the Mandarin for a public holiday.

You'll want to know: 全票

全票 — *quánpiào* — "full-price ticket".

wǒmen mǎi le liǎng zhāng quánpiào — We bought two full-price tickets.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

全票 (*quánpiào*) is built from 全 'whole' and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'complete'; no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: quánpiào*
- *Say it: quánpiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen mǎi le liǎng zhāng quánpiào* — We bought two full-price tickets.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the off season, then the Mandarin for a public holiday, then say *quánpiào* again

Before you move on

What does 全票 mean? ("Full-price ticket".) Say it once more.

432.5 guānbì — to shut down; to be shut to the public

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a public holiday, then the Mandarin for a full-price ticket.

You'll want to know: guānbì

guānbì — "to shut down; to be shut to the public".

dōngtiān zhège jǐngqū guānbì — This scenic area is closed in winter.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guānbì is built from 关 'to bar' and *bì* 'to shut', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaen* and *pejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the bar across a door and the second 'to shut a door'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: guānbì*
- *Say it: guānbì*, once more
- *Say it: dōngtiān zhège jǐngqū guānbì* — This scenic area is closed in winter.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a public holiday, then the Mandarin for a full-price ticket, then say *guānbì* again

Before you move on

What does guānbì mean? ("To shut down; to be shut to the public".) Say it once more.

Chapter 433

From Overseas

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about receiving visitors from overseas, huge crowds, Chinese people abroad and going out to sea.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 433: I can talk about receiving visitors from overseas, huge crowds, Chinese people abroad and going out to sea.*

433.1 jiēdài — to receive visitors; to take care of guests

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a full-price ticket, then the Mandarin for to be shut to the public.

You'll want to know: jiēdài

jiēdài — "to receive visitors; to take care of guests".

> *zhè jiā jiǔdiàn jiēdài le hěn duō wàiguó yóukè* — This hotel has had lots of foreign visitors.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiēdài is built from *jiē* 'to meet' and *dài* 'to wait on', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjep* and *dojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to join' and the second 'to wait for'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiēdài*
- *Say it: jiēdài*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā jiǔdiàn jiēdài le hěn duō wàiguó yóukè* — This hotel has had lots of foreign visitors.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a full-price ticket, then the Mandarin for to be shut to the public, then say *jiēdài* again

Before you move on

What does jiēdài mean? ("To receive visitors; to take care of guests".) Say it once more.

433.2 海外 (hǎiwài) — overseas; beyond the sea

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be shut to the public, then the Mandarin for to receive visitors.

You'll want to know: 海外

海外 — *hǎiwài* — "overseas; beyond the sea".

hěn duō hǎiwài yóukè zhù zài zhè jiā jiǔdiàn — A lot of visitors from overseas stay at this hotel.

The new character, in pieces: 海 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left the water piece of 洗, three strokes; on the right 每 měi, seven strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

海外 (*hǎiwài*) is built from 海 'the sea' and 外 'outside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xojX* and *ngwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, as the great pool that takes in a hundred rivers, and the second 'outside'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎiwài*
- *Say it: hǎiwài*, once more
- *Say it: hěn duō hǎiwài yóukè zhù zài zhè jiā jiǔdiàn* — A lot of visitors from overseas stay at this hotel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be shut to the public, then the Mandarin for to receive visitors, then say *hǎiwài* again

Before you move on

What does 海外 mean? ("Overseas; beyond the sea".) Say it once more.

433.3 海 — the water piece, then 每

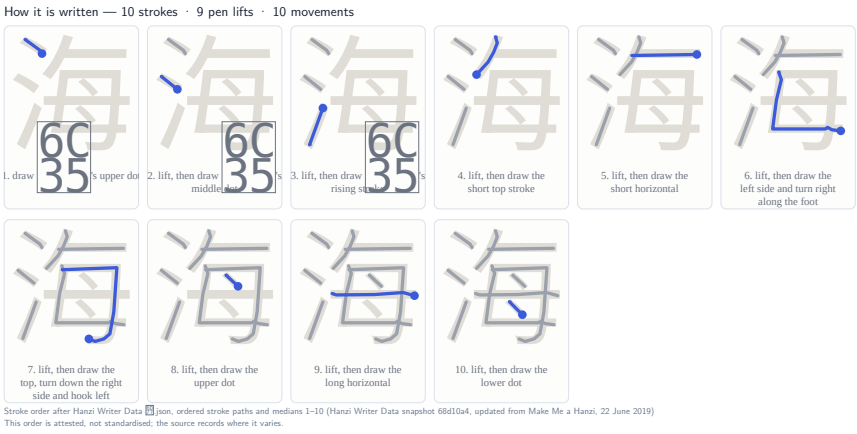
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *hǎiwài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

洗 每

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xǐ*, *měi*

Script — the water piece, then 每



How 海 is written, stroke by stroke

海

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the water piece, three strokes, as in 洗: two dots, then a stroke that rises to the right.

The right piece, 每 měi, seven strokes, as you wrote it: a short stroke falling to the left and a bar; a stroke that runs down and turns right along the foot; a bar that turns down and hooks; a dot; a long bar across; and a last dot.

3 + 7 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 海, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 海? (**Ten.**) What is the right piece? (每 **měi.**)
How many dots does 每 have? (**Two.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 海, pinned stroke paths and medians.

433.4 人山人海 (rénshānrénhǎi) — huge crowds; a sea of people

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to receive visitors, then the Mandarin for beyond the sea.

You'll want to know: 人山人海

人山人海 — *rénshānrénhǎi* — "huge crowds; a sea of people".

zhōumò gōngyuán lǐ rénshānrénhǎi — At the weekend the park is packed with people.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

人山人海 (*rénshānrénhǎi*) is built from 人 'people', 山 'a mountain' and 海 'the sea', said twice with 人: people like mountains, people like seas. The parts are inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyin*, *srean* and *xojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: rénshānrénhǎi*
- *Say it: rénshānrénhǎi*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò gōngyuán lǐ rénshānrénhǎi* — At the weekend the park is packed with people.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to receive visitors, then the Mandarin for beyond the sea, then say *rénshānrénhǎi* again

Before you move on

What does 人山人海 mean? ("Huge crowds; a sea of people".) Say it once more.

433.5 huáqiáo — overseas Chinese; a Chinese person settled abroad

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for beyond the sea, then the Mandarin for a sea of people.

You'll want to know: huáqiáo

huáqiáo — "overseas Chinese; a Chinese person settled abroad".

tā shì zhù zài hǎiwài de huáqiáo — He's one of the Chinese who live overseas.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huáqiáo is built from *huá* 'Chinese' and *qiáo* 'to live away from home', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwae* and *gjew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'flourishing' and the second 'to lodge' and 'a guest'; the sense 'Chinese' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: huáqiáo*
- *Say it: huáqiáo*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì zhù zài hǎiwài de huáqiáo* — He's one of the Chinese who live overseas.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for beyond the sea, then the Mandarin for a sea of people, then say *huáqiáo* again

Before you move on

What does huáqiáo mean? ("Overseas Chinese; a Chinese person settled abroad".) Say it once more.

433.6 出海 (chūhǎi) — to go out to sea

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sea of people, then the Mandarin for a Chinese person settled abroad.

You'll want to know: 出海

出海 — *chūhǎi* — "to go out to sea".

今天风很大我们不能出海 *jīntiān fēng hěn dà wǒmen bù néng chūhǎi* — It's very windy today, so we can't go out to sea.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出海 (*chūhǎi*) is built from 出 'to go out' and 海 'the sea', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *xojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūhǎi*
- *Say it: chūhǎi*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān fēng hěn dà wǒmen bù néng chūhǎi* — It's very windy today, so we can't go out to sea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sea of people, then the Mandarin for a Chinese person settled abroad, then say *chūhǎi* again

Before you move on

What does 出海 mean? ("To go out to sea".) Say it once more.

Chapter 434

With a Tour Group

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a tour group, where we meet, going shopping, a photo to remember and travel writing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 434: I can talk about a tour group, where we meet, going shopping, a photo to remember and travel writing.*

434.1 lǚyóutuán — tour group

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a Chinese person settled abroad, then the Mandarin for to go out to sea.

You'll want to know: lǚyóutuán

lǚyóutuán — "tour group".

> *wǒ gēn yí ge lǚyóutuán zuò fēijī qù Běijīng* — I'm flying to Beijing with a tour group.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lǚyóutuán is built from 旅游 'to travel' and *tuán* 'a group', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljoX*, *yuw* and *dwan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'round'; the sense 'a group' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lǚyóutuán*
- *Say it: lǚyóutuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēn yí ge lǚyóutuán zuò fēijī qù Běijīng* — I'm flying to Beijing with a tour group.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a Chinese person settled abroad, then the Mandarin for to go out to sea, then say *lǚyóutuán* again

Before you move on

What does lǚyóutuán mean? ("Tour group".) Say it once more.

434.2 jíhé — to gather; to assemble; to meet up as a group

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go out to sea, then the Mandarin for a tour group.

You'll want to know: jíhé

jíhé — "to gather; to assemble; to meet up as a group".

> *míngtiān zǎoshang bā diǎn wǒmen zài jiǔdiàn dàtáng jíhé* — Tomorrow at eight in the morning we meet in the hotel lobby.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jíhé is built from *jí* 'to gather' and *hé* 'to join', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzip* and *hop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to gather' and the second 'to join'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jíhé*
- *Say it: jíhé*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān zǎoshang bā diǎn wǒmen zài jiǔdiàn dàtáng jíhé* — Tomorrow at eight in the morning we meet in the hotel lobby.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go out to sea, then the Mandarin for a tour group, then say *jíhé* again

Before you move on

What does jíhé mean? ("To gather; to assemble; to meet up as a group".) Say it once more.

434.3 gòuwù — to go shopping; to do some shopping

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tour group, then the Mandarin for to meet up as a group.

You'll want to know: gòuwù

gòuwù — "to go shopping; to do some shopping".

xiàwǔ wǒmen zuò gōngjiāo qù shìzhōngxīn gòuwù — In the afternoon we're taking the bus into the centre to do some shopping.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gòuwù is built from *gòu* 'to buy' and *wù* 'a thing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwH* and *mjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to buy back' and the second as the ten thousand things.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gòuwù*
- *Say it: gòuwù*, once more
- *Say it: xiàwǔ wǒmen zuò gōngjiāo qù shìzhōngxīn gòuwù* — In the afternoon we're taking the bus into the centre to do some shopping.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tour group, then the Mandarin for to meet up as a group, then say *gòuwù* again

Before you move on

What does gòuwù mean? ("To go shopping; to do some shopping".) Say it once more.

434.4 liúniàn — to keep as a souvenir

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to meet up as a group, then the Mandarin for to do some shopping.

You'll want to know: liúniàn

liúniàn — "to keep as a souvenir".

wǒmen zài ménkǒu zhàoxiàng liúniàn — We're having our photo taken at the entrance to remember the trip.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liúniàn is built from *liú* 'to keep' and *niàn* 'to remember', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *nemH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stay' and the second 'to think of'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: liúniàn*
- *Say it: liúniàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài ménkǒu zhàoxiàng liúniàn* — We're having our photo taken at the entrance to remember the trip.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to meet up as a group, then the Mandarin for to do some shopping, then say *liúniàn* again

Before you move on

What does liúniàn mean? ("To keep as a souvenir".) Say it once more.

434.5 游记 (yóujì) — travel notes; account of a journey

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to do some shopping, then the Mandarin for to keep as a souvenir.

You'll want to know: 游记

游记 — *yóujì* — "travel notes; account of a journey".

huílai yǐhòu tā xiě le yì běn yóujì — After she came back, she wrote a book about the trip.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

游记 (*yóujì*) is built from 游 'to roam' and 记 'to record', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *kiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to record'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóujì*
- *Say it: yóujì*, once more
- *Say it: huílai yǐhòu tā xiě le yì běn yóujì* — After she came back, she wrote a book about the trip.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to do some shopping, then the Mandarin for to keep as a souvenir, then say *yóujì* again

Before you move on

What does 游记 mean? ("Travel notes; account of a journey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 435

At the Top

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about climbing a mountain, the summit, a sunrise, a magnificent view and the way down.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 435: I can talk about climbing a mountain, the summit, a sunrise, a magnificent view and the way down.*

435.1 dēngshān — to climb a mountain

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep as a souvenir, then the Mandarin for an account of a journey.

You'll want to know: dēngshān

dēngshān — "to climb a mountain".

> *zhōumò wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù dēngshān* — At the weekend we're taking the train to go climbing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēngshān is built from *dēng* 'to ascend' and 山 'a mountain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong* and *srean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and 'to go up'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēngshān*
- *Say it: dēngshān*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù dēngshān* — At the weekend we're taking the train to go climbing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep as a souvenir, then the Mandarin for an account of a journey, then say *dēngshān* again

Before you move on

What does dēngshān mean? ("To climb a mountain".) Say it once more.

435.2 shāndǐng — top of a mountain; summit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an account of a journey, then the Mandarin for to climb a mountain.

You'll want to know: shāndǐng

shāndǐng — "top of a mountain; summit".

cóng zhèr wǎng qián zǒu shí fēnzhōng jiù dào shāndǐng le — Walk on for ten minutes from here and you'll be at the top.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāndǐng is built from 山 'a mountain' and *dǐng* 'the top', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srean* and *tengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the crown of the head.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāndǐng*
- *Say it: shāndǐng*, once more
- *Say it: cóng zhèr wǎng qián zǒu shí fēnzhōng jiù dào shāndǐng le* — Walk on for ten minutes from here and you'll be at the top.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an account of a journey, then the Mandarin for to climb a mountain, then say *shāndǐng* again

Before you move on

What does shāndǐng mean? ("Top of a mountain; summit".) Say it once more.

435.3 日出 (rìchū) — sunrise

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to climb a mountain, then the Mandarin for the summit.

You'll want to know: 日出

日出 — *rìchū* — "sunrise".

我们早上五点起来看日出 *wǒmen zǎoshang wǔ diǎn qǐlai kàn rìchū* — We're getting up at five in the morning to watch the sunrise.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

日出 (*rìchū*) is built from 日 'the sun' and 出 'to come out', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyit* and *tsyhwit* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: rìchū*
- *Say it: rìchū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zǎoshang wǔ diǎn qǐlai kàn rìchū* — We're getting up at five in the morning to watch the sunrise.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to climb a mountain, then the Mandarin for the summit, then say *rìchū* again

Before you move on

What does 日出 mean? ("Sunrise".) Say it once more.

435.4 zhuàngguān — magnificent; spectacular

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the summit, then the Mandarin for the sunrise.

You'll want to know: zhuàngguān

zhuàngguān — "magnificent; spectacular".

shāndǐng de rìchū hěn zhuàngguān — The sunrise from the summit is spectacular.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuàngguān is built from *zhuàng* 'grand' and *guān* 'a sight', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrjangH* and *kwan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'big' and the second 'to view'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuàngguān*
- *Say it: zhuàngguān*, once more
- *Say it: shāndǐng de rìchū hěn zhuàngguān* — The sunrise from the summit is spectacular.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the summit, then the Mandarin for the sunrise, then say *zhuàngguān* again

Before you move on

What does zhuàngguān mean? ("Magnificent; spectacular".) Say it once more.

435.5 下山 (xiàshān) — to come down a mountain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the sunrise, then the Mandarin for spectacular.

You'll want to know: 下山

下山 — *xiàshān* — "to come down a mountain".

> 下山以后我们坐车回酒店 *xiàshān yǐhòu wǒmen zuò chē huí jiǔdiàn* — After coming down the mountain, we take the bus back to the hotel.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

下山 (*xiàshān*) is built from 下 'to go down' and 山 'a mountain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *srean* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'low' and 'to come down'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàshān*
- *Say it: xiàshān*, once more
- *Say it: xiàshān yǐhòu wǒmen zuò chē huí jiǔdiàn* — After coming down the mountain, we take the bus back to the hotel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the sunrise, then the Mandarin for spectacular, then say *xiàshān* again

Before you move on

What does 下山 mean? ("To come down a mountain".) Say it once more.

435.6 Looking back: from Seeing the Sights to At the Top

Say the Mandarin for to go sightseeing and a historic site.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to go sightseeing, a historic site, a scenic area, to take a selfie, the peak season
- *Say it:* to give a running commentary, a spring outing, a pleasure boat, many, to pose for a group photo
- *Say it:* few, the off season, a public holiday, a full-price ticket, to be shut to the public
- *Say it:* to receive visitors, beyond the sea, a sea of people, a Chinese person settled abroad, to go out to sea
- *Say it:* a tour group, to meet up as a group, to do some shopping, to keep as a souvenir, an account of a journey

- *Say it:* to climb a mountain, the summit, the sunrise, spectacular, to come down a mountain
- *Read it:* 游 海 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To go sightseeing? (*guānguāng.*) A historic site? (*gǔjì.*) A scenic area? (*jǐngqū.*) To take a selfie? (*zìpāi.*) The peak season? (*wàngjì.*) To give a running commentary? (解说, *jiěshuō.*) A spring outing? (春游, *chūnyóu.*) A pleasure boat? (游船, *yóuchuán.*) Many? (多, *duō.*) To pose for a group photo? (*héyǐng.*) Few? (少, *shǎo.*) The off season? (*dànjì.*) A public holiday? (节假日, *jiéjiàrì.*) A full-price ticket? (全票, *quánpiào.*) To be shut to the public? (*guānbì.*) To receive visitors? (*jiēdài.*) Beyond the sea? (海外, *hǎiwài.*) A sea of people? (人山人海, *rénshānrénhǎi.*) A Chinese person settled abroad? (*huáqiáo.*) To go out to sea? (出海, *chūhǎi.*) A tour group? (*lǚyóutuán.*) To meet up as a group? (*jíhé.*) To do some shopping? (*gòuwù.*) To keep as a souvenir? (*liúniàn.*) An account of a journey? (游记, *yóujì.*) To climb a mountain? (*dēngshān.*) The summit? (*shāndǐng.*) The sunrise? (日出, *rìchū.*) Spectacular? (*zhuàngguān.*) To come down a mountain? (下山, *xiàshān.*)

Chapter 436

North and South

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the lie of the land, the south and the north, a dialect and an accent.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 436: I can talk about the lie of the land, the south and the north, a dialect and an accent.*

436.1 dìxíng — terrain; lie of the land

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for spectacular, then the Mandarin for to come down a mountain.

You'll want to know: dìxíng

dìxíng — "terrain; lie of the land".

> *zhège dìqū de dìxíng hěn tèbié* — The land in this region has an unusual shape.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìxíng is built from 地 'the earth' and *xíng* 'a shape', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *heng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the look of a thing.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìxíng*
- *Say it: dìxíng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège dìqū de dìxíng hěn tèbié* — The land in this region has an unusual shape.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for spectacular, then the Mandarin for to come down a mountain, then say *dìxíng* again

Before you move on

What does dìxíng mean? ("Terrain; lie of the land".) Say it once more.

436.2 南方 (nánfāng) — the south of the country; southern China

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come down a mountain, then the Mandarin for the lie of the land.

You'll want to know: 南方

南方 — *nánfāng* — "the south of the country; southern China".

dōngtiān wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù nánfāng — In winter we take the train down south.

The new character, in pieces: 方 — four strokes: a dot, a long bar, a stroke that turns down and hooks, and a long stroke falling to the left. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

南方 (*nánfāng*) is built from 南 'south' and 方 'a quarter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nom* and *pjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the second as the four quarters of the world.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánfāng*
- *Say it: nánfāng*, once more
- *Say it: dōngtiān wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù nánfāng* — In winter we take the train down south.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come down a mountain, then the Mandarin for the lie of the land, then say *nánfāng* again

Before you move on

What does 南方 mean? ("The south of the country; southern China".) Say it once more.

436.3 方 — a dot over a bar, a hook and a long stroke

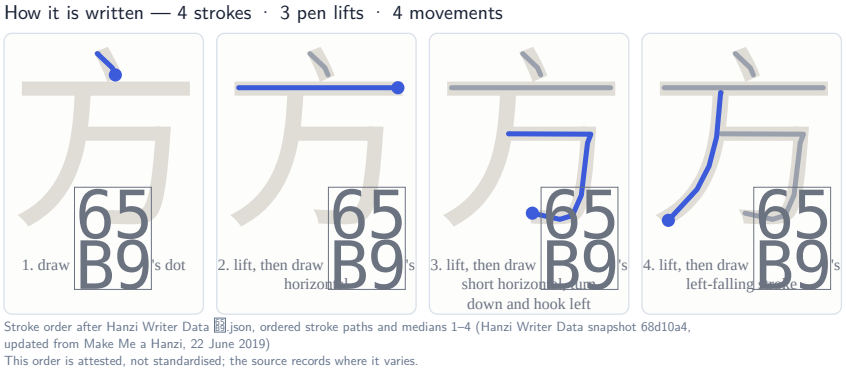
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *nánfāng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  南 方

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nán*, *wàn*

Script — a dot over a bar, a hook and a long stroke



How 方 is written, stroke by stroke

方

One piece, four strokes. Count the strokes this time: there is only one piece.

A dot on top, in the middle.

A long bar under it.

From under the bar, a stroke that runs a little to the right, turns down and hooks to the left at the foot. Then **a long stroke falling to the left**, also from under the bar. These last two are made as in 万.

1 + 1 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 方, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 方? (**Four**.) What comes first? (**A dot**.) Which stroke hooks? (**The third: it runs right, turns down and hooks**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 方, pinned stroke paths and medians.

436.4 北方 (běifāng) — the north of the country; northern China

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the lie of the land, then the Mandarin for the south of the country.

You'll want to know: 北方

北方 — *běifāng* — "the north of the country; northern China".

wǒ zhù zài běifāng dōngtiān hěn lěng — I live in the north, where the winters are cold.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

北方 (*běifāng*) is built from 北 'north' and 方 'a quarter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pok* and *pjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: běifāng*
- *Say it: běifāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhù zài běifāng dōngtiān hěn lěng* — I live in the north, where the winters are cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the lie of the land, then the Mandarin for the south of the country, then say *běifāng* again

Before you move on

What does 北方 mean? ("The north of the country; northern China".) Say it once more.

436.5 fāngyán — dialect

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the south of the country, then the Mandarin for the north of the country.

You'll want to know: fāngyán

fāngyán — "dialect".

zhèr de rén shuō fāngyán wǒ tīng bu dǒng — People here speak a dialect I can't understand.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāngyán is built from 方 'a region' and *yán* 'speech', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjang* and *ngjon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'speech'. The Guangyun itself quotes an old book called the Fangyan, a record of the speech of the regions.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāngyán*
- *Say it: fāngyán*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de rén shuō fāngyán wǒ tīng bu dǒng* — People here speak a dialect I can't understand.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the south of the country, then the Mandarin for the north of the country, then say *fāngyán* again

Before you move on

What does fāngyán mean? ("Dialect".) Say it once more.

436.6 口音 (kǒuyīn) — accent

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the north of the country, then the Mandarin for a regional dialect.

You'll want to know: 口音

口音 — *kǒuyīn* — "accent".

他说话有南方口音 *tā shuōhuà yǒu nánfāng kǒuyīn* — He speaks with a southern accent.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

口音 (*kǒuyīn*) is built from 口 'the mouth' and 音 'a sound', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuwX* and *'im* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a sound'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǒuyīn*
- *Say it: kǒuyīn*, once more
- *Say it: tā shuōhuà yǒu nánfāng kǒuyīn* — He speaks with a southern accent.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the north of the country, then the Mandarin for a regional dialect, then say *kǒuyīn* again

Before you move on

What does 口音 mean? ("Accent".) Say it once more.

Chapter 437

Mountains and Plains

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a mountain area, a plain, a desert, a plateau and moving abroad.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 437: I can talk about a mountain area, a plain, a desert, a plateau and moving abroad.*

437.1 山区 (shānqū) — mountain area

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a regional dialect, then the Mandarin for a regional accent.

You'll want to know: 山区

山区 — *shānqū* — "mountain area".

> *wǒ nǎinai zhù zài shānqū* — My grandmother lives up in the mountains.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

山区 (*shānqū*) is built from 山 'a mountain' and 区 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srean* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary gives the second as the name of a marsh, and the sense 'an area' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shānqū*
- *Say it: shānqū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nǎinai zhù zài shānqū* — My grandmother lives up in the mountains.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a regional dialect, then the Mandarin for a regional accent, then say *shānqū* again

Before you move on

What does 山区 mean? ("Mountain area".) Say it once more.

437.2 píngyuán — plain; flat open land

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a regional accent, then the Mandarin for a mountain area.

You'll want to know: píngyuán

píngyuán — "plain; flat open land".

běifāng de píngyuán hěn dà — The plains in the north are huge.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píngyuán is built from *píng* 'level' and *yuán* 'broad flat land', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaeng* and *ngjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'right' and 'at peace' and the second, after an older dictionary, as broad flat land; the sense 'level' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: píngyuán*
- *Say it: píngyuán*, once more
- *Say it: běifāng de píngyuán hěn dà* — The plains in the north are huge.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a regional accent, then the Mandarin for a mountain area, then say *píngyuán* again

Before you move on

What does píngyuán mean? ("Plain; flat open land".) Say it once more.

437.3 shāmò — desert

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a mountain area, then the Mandarin for flat open land.

You'll want to know: shāmò

shāmò — "desert".

míngtiān wǒmen zuò chē qù shāmò — Tomorrow we're driving out to the desert.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāmò is built from *shā* 'sand' and *mò* 'a waste', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srae* and *mak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as stones scattered by water and gives the pair itself under the second.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāmò*
- *Say it: shāmò*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān wǒmen zuò chē qù shāmò* — Tomorrow we're driving out to the desert.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a mountain area, then the Mandarin for flat open land, then say *shāmò* again

Before you move on

What does shāmò mean? ("Desert".) Say it once more.

437.4 gāoyuán — plateau; highland

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for flat open land, then the Mandarin for a desert.

You'll want to know: gāoyuán

gāoyuán — "plateau; highland".

xīnán yǒu hěn duō gāoyuán — There are a lot of high plateaus in the southwest.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gāoyuán is built from 高 'high' and *yuán* 'broad flat land', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *ngjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'high' and 'lofty'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāoyuán*
- *Say it: gāoyuán*, once more
- *Say it: xīnán yǒu hěn duō gāoyuán* — There are a lot of high plateaus in the southwest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for flat open land, then the Mandarin for a desert, then say *gāoyuán* again

Before you move on

What does gāoyuán mean? ("Plateau; highland".) Say it once more.

437.5 yímín — to emigrate; to settle abroad

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a desert, then the Mandarin for a high plateau.

You'll want to know: yímín

yímín — "to emigrate; to settle abroad".

tāmen quánjiā yímín qù le guówài — Their whole family emigrated abroad.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yímín is built from *yí* 'to move' and *mín* 'the people', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ye* and *mjin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to shift' and the second 'the common people'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yímín*
- *Say it: yímín*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen quánjiā yímín qù le guówài* — Their whole family emigrated abroad.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a desert, then the Mandarin for a high plateau, then say *yímín* again

Before you move on

What does yímín mean? ("To emigrate; to settle abroad".) Say it once more.

Chapter 438

The North

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about developing an area, the northern and western parts, a part of the visitors and all of the luggage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 438: I can talk about developing an area, the northern and western parts, a part of the visitors and all of the luggage.*

438.1 开发 (kāifā) — to open up land for use

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a high plateau, then the Mandarin for to emigrate.

You'll want to know: 开发

开发 — *kāifā* — "to open up land for use".

> 这个山区还没有开发 *zhège shānqū hái méiyǒu kāifā* — This mountain area hasn't been developed yet.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开发 (*kāifā*) is built from 开 'to open' and 发 'to set going', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to start' and 'to raise'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāifā*
- *Say it: kāifā*, once more
- *Say it: zhège shānqū hái méiyǒu kāifā* — This mountain area hasn't been developed yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a high plateau, then the Mandarin for to emigrate, then say *kāifā* again

Before you move on

What does 开发 mean? ("To open up land for use".) Say it once more.

438.2 北部 (běibù) — northern part

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to emigrate, then the Mandarin for to open up land for use.

You'll want to know: 北部

北部 — *běibù* — "northern part".

我们坐火车去中国北部 *wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù Zhōngguó běibù* — We're taking the train up to the north of China.

The new character, in pieces: 部 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left five strokes, a dot, a bar, two short strokes and a long bar, over 口 kǒu; on the right the right piece of 那, two strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

北部 (*běibù*) is built from 北 'north' and 部 'a part', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pok* and *buX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the second as a body of troops; the sense 'a part of a whole' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: běibù*
- *Say it: běibù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù Zhōngguó běibù* — We're taking the train up to the north of China.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to emigrate, then the Mandarin for to open up land for use, then say *běibù* again

Before you move on

What does 北部 mean? ("Northern part".) Say it once more.

438.3 部 — five strokes over 口, then the right piece of 那

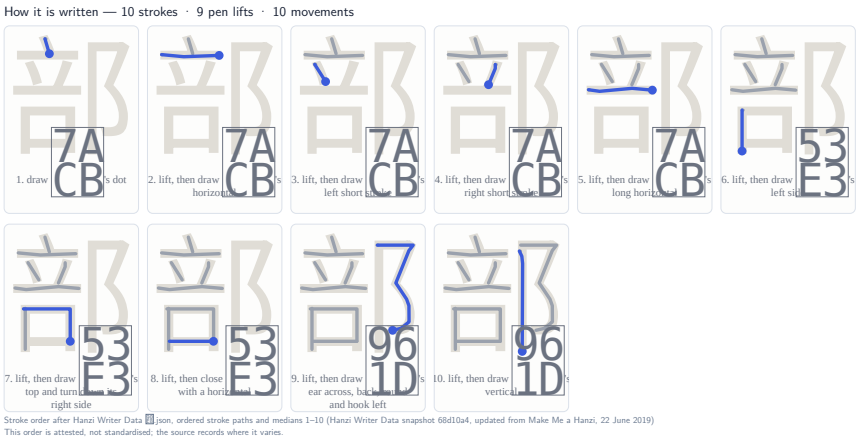
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *běibù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  那 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nà*, *kǒu*

Script — five strokes over 口, then the right piece of 那



How 部 *is written, stroke by stroke*

部

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, eight strokes, in two parts. On top, five strokes: a dot, a bar, then a short dot on the left and a short stroke falling to the left on the right, and a long bar under them. Under them, 口 kǒu, three strokes.

The right piece, two strokes, as on the right of 那: a stroke that runs right, bends back and curls down to a hook, then a long vertical.

5 + 3 + 2 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 部, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 部? (**Ten.**) What sits under the five strokes on top? (口.) Where has your hand made the right piece before? (**On the right of** 那.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 部, pinned stroke paths and medians.

438.4 西部 (xībù) — western part; the western regions

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to open up land for use, then the Mandarin for the northern part.

You'll want to know: 西部

西部 — *xībù* — "western part; the western regions".

中国西部的山很高 *Zhōngguó xībù de shān hěn gāo* — The mountains in western China are very high.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

西部 (*xībù*) is built from 西 'west' and 部 'a part', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sej* and *buX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xībù*
- *Say it: xībù*, once more
- *Say it: Zhōngguó xībù de shān hěn gāo* — The mountains in western China are very high.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to open up land for use, then the Mandarin for the northern part, then say *xībù* again

Before you move on

What does 西部 mean? ("Western part; the western regions".) Say it once more.

438.5 bùfen — part; section (of a whole)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the northern part, then the Mandarin for the western part.

You'll want to know: bùfen

bùfen — "part; section (of a whole)".

> *dà bùfen yóukè zhù zài běibù* — Most of the visitors are staying in the north.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bùfen is built from 部 'a section' and *fèn* 'a share', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *buX* and *bjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a portion that is measured out; in this word it is said light.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùfen*
- *Say it: bùfen*, once more
- *Say it: dà bùfen yóukè zhù zài běibù* — Most of the visitors are staying in the north.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the northern part, then the Mandarin for the western part, then say *bùfen* again

Before you move on

What does bùfen mean? ("Part; section (of a whole)".) Say it once more.

438.6 全部 (quánbù) — all of it; the whole

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the western part, then the Mandarin for a part of a whole.

You'll want to know: 全部

全部 — *quánbù* — "all of it; the whole".

> *wǒmen de xíngli quánbù fàng zài chē lǐ* — All our luggage is in the car.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

全部 (*quánbù*) is built from 全 'whole' and 部 'a part', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjwen* and *buX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'complete'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: quánbù*
- *Say it: quánbù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de xíngli quánbù fàng zài chē lǐ* — All our luggage is in the car.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the western part, then the Mandarin for a part of a whole, then say *quánbù* again

Before you move on

What does 全部 mean? ("All of it; the whole".) Say it once more.

Chapter 439

Country Life

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about rice paddies, an orchard, a farm stay, ducks and getting away to unwind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 439: I can talk about rice paddies, an orchard, a farm stay, ducks and getting away to unwind.*

439.1 dàotián — rice paddy; paddy field

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a part of a whole, then the Mandarin for all of it.

You'll want to know: dàotián

dàotián — "rice paddy; paddy field".

> *wǒ yéye nǎinai zhù zài dàotián pángbiān* — My grandparents live next to the rice paddies.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàotián is built from *dào* 'rice in the field' and *tián* 'a field', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dawX* and *den* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as rice and the second, after an older book, as land that has been ploughed.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàotián*
- *Say it: dàotián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yéye nǎinai zhù zài dàotián pángbiān* — My grandparents live next to the rice paddies.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a part of a whole, then the Mandarin for all of it, then say *dàotián* again

Before you move on

What does dàotián mean? ("Rice paddy; paddy field".) Say it once more.

439.2 guǒyuán — orchard

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all of it, then the Mandarin for a rice paddy.

You'll want to know: guǒyuán

guǒyuán — "orchard".

zhōumò wǒmen kāichē qù guǒyuán — At the weekend we're driving out to the orchard.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǒyuán is built from 果 'fruit' and *yuán* 'a garden', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaX* and *hjwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the fruit of a tree and the second as a garden.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǒyuán*
- *Say it: guǒyuán*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen kāichē qù guǒyuán* — At the weekend we're driving out to the orchard.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all of it, then the Mandarin for a rice paddy, then say *guǒyuán* again

Before you move on

What does guǒyuán mean? ("Orchard".) Say it once more.

439.3 nóngjiālè — farm stay; country guesthouse

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a rice paddy, then the Mandarin for an orchard.

You'll want to know: nóngjiālè

nóngjiālè — "farm stay; country guesthouse".

wǒmen zhù zài yì jiā nóngjiālè — We're staying at a farm guesthouse.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nóngjiālè is built from *nóng* 'farming', 家 'a family' and 乐 'joy', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *nowng*, *kae* and *lak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as working the fields. The name for a farm that takes guests is modern.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: nóngjiālè*
- *Say it: nóngjiālè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhù zài yì jiā nóngjiālè* — We're staying at a farm guesthouse.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a rice paddy, then the Mandarin for an orchard, then say *nóngjiālè* again

Before you move on

What does nóngjiālè mean? ("Farm stay; country guesthouse".) Say it once more.

439.4 yāzi — duck

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an orchard, then the Mandarin for a farm stay.

You'll want to know: yāzi

yāzi — "duck".

nǎinai jiā yǒu shí zhī yāzi — Grandma keeps ten ducks.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yāzi is built from *yā* 'a duck' and the noun ending *zi*. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *'aep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as a water bird.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yāzi*
- *Say it: yāzi*, once more
- *Say it: nǎinai jiā yǒu shí zhī yāzi* — Grandma keeps ten ducks.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an orchard, then the Mandarin for a farm stay, then say *yāzi* again

Before you move on

What does yāzi mean? (“Duck”.) Say it once more.

439.5 sànxīn — to take one’s mind off things; to unwind

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a farm stay, then the Mandarin for a duck.

You’ll want to know: sànxīn

sànxīn — “to take one’s mind off things; to unwind”.

lèi de shíhou wǒ xǐhuan qù nóngcūn sànxīn — When I’m tired, I like to go to the countryside to unwind.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sànxīn is built from *sàn* ’to scatter’ and 心 ’the heart’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sanH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’to break apart’ and ’to spread’: cares scattered from the heart.

What you’ve built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: sànxīn*
- *Say it: sànxīn*, once more
- *Say it: lèi de shíhou wǒ xǐhuan qù nóngcūn sànxīn* — When I'm tired, I like to go to the countryside to unwind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a farm stay, then the Mandarin for a duck, then say *sànxīn* again

Before you move on

What does sànxīn mean? ("To take one's mind off things; to unwind".) Say it once more.

Chapter 440

A Mountain Village

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about market day, a mountain village, its head and its villagers, and staying with a family.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 440: I can talk about market day, a mountain village, its head and its villagers, and staying with a family.*

440.1 gǎnjí — to go to market day; to go to a country market

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a duck, then the Mandarin for to take one's mind off things.

You'll want to know: gǎnjí

gǎnjí — "to go to market day; to go to a country market".

> *nǎinai měi ge xīngqī qù gǎnjí* — Grandma goes to market day every week.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎnjí is built from *gǎn* 'to hurry to' and *jí* 'a gathering'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), glossed 'to gather'; no dictionary we use records an older form of *gǎn* in this sense, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnjí*
- *Say it: gǎnjí*, once more
- *Say it: nǎinai měi ge xīngqī qù gǎnjí* — Grandma goes to market day every week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a duck, then the Mandarin for to take one's mind off things, then say *gǎnjí* again

Before you move on

What does gǎnjí mean? ("To go to market day; to go to a country market".) Say it once more.

440.2 山村 (shāncūn) — mountain village

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take one's mind off things, then the Mandarin for to go to market day.

You'll want to know: 山村

山村 — *shāncūn* — "mountain village".

tā zhù zài yí ge xiǎo shāncūn — He lives in a little mountain village.

The new character, in pieces: 村 — seven strokes in two pieces: on the left the tree piece of 机, four strokes; on the right the right piece of 对, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

山村 (*shāncūn*) is built from 山 'a mountain' and 村 'a village', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srean* and *tshwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a farmstead.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāncūn*
- *Say it: shāncūn*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhù zài yí ge xiǎo shāncūn* — He lives in a little mountain village.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take one's mind off things, then the Mandarin for to go to market day, then say *shāncūn* again

Before you move on

What does 山村 mean? ("Mountain village".) Say it once more.

440.3 村 — the tree piece, then the right piece of 对

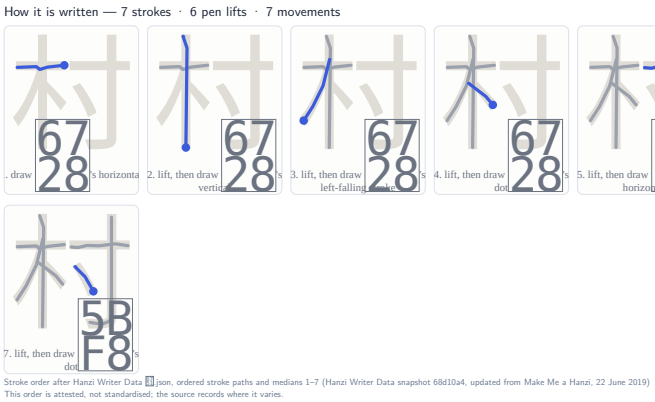
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shāncūn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  机 对

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jī*, *duì*

Script — the tree piece, then the right piece of 对



How 村 *is written, stroke by stroke*

村

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the tree piece, four strokes, as on the left of 机: a bar, a vertical, a stroke falling to the left, and a short dot to the right.

The right piece, three strokes, as on the right of 对: a bar, a vertical with a hook at the foot, and a dot to the left of it.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 村, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 村? (**Seven**.) What is the left piece? (**The tree piece, as in 机.**) Where does the last dot go? (**To the left of the hooked vertical**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 村, pinned stroke paths and medians.

440.4 村长 (cūnzhǎng) — village head

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go to market day, then the Mandarin for a mountain village.

You'll want to know: 村长

村长 — *cūnzhǎng* — "village head".

cūnzhǎng dài wǒmen qù tā jiā — The village head takes us to his house.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

村长 (*cūnzhǎng*) is built from 村 'a village' and 长 'the head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshwon* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'big'; in this sense 长 is said zhǎng, not cháng.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūnzhǎng*
- *Say it: cūnzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: cūnzhǎng dài wǒmen qù tā jiā* — The village head takes us to his house.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go to market day, then the Mandarin for a mountain village, then say *cūnzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 村长 mean? ("Village head".) Say it once more.

440.5 cūnmín — villager

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a mountain village, then the Mandarin for the village head.

You'll want to know: cūnmín

cūnmín — "villager".

> *zhèr de cūnmín dōu hěn rèqíng* — The villagers here are all very friendly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cūnmín is built from 村 'a village' and *mín* 'the people', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshwon* and *mjin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūnmín*
- *Say it: cūnmín*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de cūnmín dōu hěn rèqíng* — The villagers here are all very friendly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a mountain village, then the Mandarin for the village head, then say *cūnmín* again

Before you move on

What does cūnmín mean? ("Villager".) Say it once more.

440.6 jièsù — to lodge with a local family; to stay the night at someone's home

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the village head, then the Mandarin for a villager.

You'll want to know: jièsù

jièsù — "to lodge with a local family; to stay the night at someone's home".

> *zhǎo bu dào jiǔdiàn de shíhou wǒmen zài cūnmín jiā jièsù* — When we can't find a hotel, we stay the night with a village family.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jièsù is built from *jiè* 'to borrow' and *sù* 'to stay the night', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjaeH* and *sjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to borrow' and the second 'a lodging'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jièsù*
- *Say it: jièsù*, once more
- *Say it: zhǎo bu dào jiǔdiàn de shíhou wǒmen zài cūnmín jiā jièsù* — When we can't find a hotel, we stay the night with a village family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the village head, then the Mandarin for a villager, then say *jièsù* again

Before you move on

What does jièsù mean? ("To lodge with a local family; to stay the night at someone's home".) Say it once more.

Chapter 441

Out in the Open

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the outskirts, the open country, a tent, lighting a fire and a lake made by nature.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 441: I can talk about the outskirts, the open country, a tent, lighting a fire and a lake made by nature.*

441.1 jiāoqū — suburbs; outskirts

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a villager, then the Mandarin for to lodge with a local family.

You'll want to know: jiāoqū

jiāoqū — "suburbs; outskirts".

> *wǒmen zhù zài jiāoqū zuò dìtiě qù shìzhōngxīn* — We live in the suburbs and take the underground into the centre.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāoqū is built from *jiāo* 'the land beyond the walls' and ⊠ 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaew* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the land outside a walled town.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāoqū*
- *Say it: jiāoqū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhù zài jiāoqū zuò dìtiě qù shìzhōngxīn* — We live in the suburbs and take the underground into the centre.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a villager, then the Mandarin for to lodge with a local family, then say *jiāoqū* again

Before you move on

What does jiāoqū mean? ("Suburbs; outskirts".) Say it once more.

441.2 yěwài — the open country; the wild

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lodge with a local family, then the Mandarin for the outskirts of a city.

You'll want to know: yěwài

yěwài — "the open country; the wild".

zhōumò wǒmen zuò chē qù yěwài — At the weekend we're driving out into the open country.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yěwài is built from *yě* 'open fields' and 外 'outside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yaeX* and *ngwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, as the land beyond the town.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yěwài*
- *Say it: yěwài*, once more
- *Say it: zhōumò wǒmen zuò chē qù yěwài* — At the weekend we're driving out into the open country.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lodge with a local family, then the Mandarin for the outskirts of a city, then say *yěwài* again

Before you move on

What does yěwài mean? ("The open country; the wild".) Say it once more.

441.3 zhàngpeng — tent

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the outskirts of a city, then the Mandarin for out in the wild.

You'll want to know: zhàngpeng

zhàngpeng — "tent".

> *wǎnshang wǒmen zài zhàngpeng lǐ shuìjiào* — At night we sleep in the tent.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhàngpeng is built from *zhàng* 'a curtain' and *péng* 'an awning', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjangH* and *buwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a woven cover over a boat; in this word it is said light.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhàngpeng*
- *Say it: zhàngpeng*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang wǒmen zài zhàngpeng lǐ shuìjiào* — At night we sleep in the tent.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the outskirts of a city, then the Mandarin for out in the wild, then say *zhàngpeng* again

Before you move on

What does zhàngpeng mean? ("Tent".) Say it once more.

441.4 生火 (shēnghuǒ) — to light a fire

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for out in the wild, then the Mandarin for a tent.

You'll want to know: 生火

生火 — *shēnghuǒ* — "to light a fire".

天冷了我们在村子外边生火 *tiān lěng le wǒmen zài cūnzi wàibian shēnghuǒ* — It's got cold, so we're lighting a fire outside the village.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

生火 (*shēnghuǒ*) is built from 生 'to bring to life' and 火 'fire', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaeng* and *xwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnghuǒ*
- *Say it: shēnghuǒ*, once more
- *Say it: tiān lěng le wǒmen zài cūnzi wàibian shēnghuǒ* — It's got cold, so we're lighting a fire outside the village.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for out in the wild, then the Mandarin for a tent, then say *shēnghuǒ* again

Before you move on

What does 生火 mean? ("To light a fire".) Say it once more.

441.5 天然 (tiānrán) — natural; made by nature

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tent, then the Mandarin for to light a fire.

You'll want to know: 天然

天然 — *tiānrán* — "natural; made by nature".

zhè shì yí ge tiānrán de hú — This is a natural lake.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

天然 (*tiānrán*) is built from 天 'heaven' and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *then* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a particle and 'thus': so by heaven, not by people. How the pair came to mean 'natural' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānrán*
- *Say it: tiānrán*, once more

- *Say it: zhè shì yí ge tiānrán de hú* — This is a natural lake.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tent, then the Mandarin for to light a fire, then say *tiānrán* again

Before you move on

What does 天然 mean? ("Natural; made by nature".) Say it once more.

441.6 Looking back: from North and South to Out in the Open

Say the Mandarin for the lie of the land and the south of the country.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the lie of the land, the south of the country, the north of the country, a regional dialect, a regional accent
- *Say it:* a mountain area, flat open land, a desert, a high plateau, to emigrate
- *Say it:* to open up land for use, the northern part, the western part, a part of a whole, all of it
- *Say it:* a rice paddy, an orchard, a farm stay, a duck, to take one's mind off things
- *Say it:* to go to market day, a mountain village, the village head, a villager, to lodge with a local family
- *Say it:* the outskirts of a city, out in the wild, a tent, to light a fire, made by nature
- *Read it:* 方 部 村 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The lie of the land? (*dìxíng.*) The south of the country? (南方, *nánfāng.*) The north of the country? (北方, *běifāng.*) A regional

dialect? (*fāngyán.*) A regional accent? (口音, *kǒuyīn.*) A mountain area? (山区, *shānqū.*) Flat open land? (*píngyuán.*) A desert? (*shāmò.*) A high plateau? (*gāoyuán.*) To emigrate? (*yímín.*) To open up land for use? (开发, *kāifā.*) The northern part? (北部, *běibù.*) The western part? (西部, *xībù.*) A part of a whole? (*bùfen.*) All of it? (全部, *quánbù.*) A rice paddy? (*dàotián.*) An orchard? (*guǒyuán.*) A farm stay? (*nóngjiālè.*) A duck? (*yāzi.*) To take one's mind off things? (*sànxīn.*) To go to market day? (*gǎnjí.*) A mountain village? (山村, *shāncūn.*) The village head? (村长, *cūnzhǎng.*) A villager? (*cūnmín.*) To lodge with a local family? (*jièsù.*) The outskirts of a city? (*jiāoqū.*) Out in the wild? (*yěwài.*) A tent? (*zhàngpeng.*) To light a fire? (生火, *shēnghuǒ.*) Made by nature? (天然, *tiānrán.*)

Chapter 442

The River

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the far bank, a river, its upper reaches, a river in flood and a great river.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 442: I can talk about the far bank, a river, its upper reaches, a river in flood and a great river.*

442.1 duì'àn — the far bank; the opposite bank

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to light a fire, then the Mandarin for made by nature.

You'll want to know: duì'àn

duì'àn — "the far bank; the opposite bank".

> *wǒmen zuò chuán qù duì'àn* — We're taking a boat across to the other side.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duì'àn is built from 对 'facing' and *àn* 'a bank', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *twojH* and *nganH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the high edge of the water.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: duì'àn*
- *Say it: duì'àn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò chuán qù duì'àn* — We're taking a boat across to the other side.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to light a fire, then the Mandarin for made by nature, then say *duì'àn* again

Before you move on

What does duì'àn mean? ("The far bank; the opposite bank".) Say it once more.

442.2 河 (hé) — river

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for made by nature, then the Mandarin for the far bank.

You'll want to know: 河

河 — *hé* — "river".

cūnzi qiánbian yǒu yì tiáo hé — There's a river in front of the village.

The new character, in pieces: 河 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left the water piece of 洗, three strokes; on the right 可 kě, five strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

河 (*hé*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *ha* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), where it is the name of one river, the one said to rise in the far west and run to the sea; the sense 'any river' is usually

explained as a widening of that name.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hé*
- *Say it: hé*, once more
- *Say it: cūnzi qiánbian yǒu yì tiáo hé* — There's a river in front of the village.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for made by nature, then the Mandarin for the far bank, then say *hé* again

Before you move on

What does 河 mean? ("River".) Say it once more.

442.3 河 — the water piece, then 可

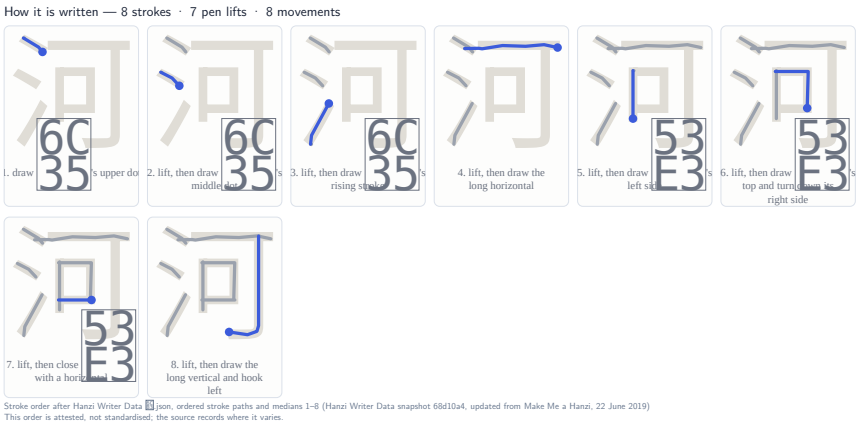
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *hé* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  洗 可

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *xǐ*, *kě*

Script — the water piece, then 可



How 河 is written, stroke by stroke

河

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the water piece, three strokes, as in 洗: two dots, then a stroke that rises to the right.

The right piece, 可 kě, five strokes, as you wrote it: a long bar; under it 口, three strokes, set to the left; then a long vertical down the right side that hooks to the left at the foot.

3 + 5 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 河, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 河? (**Eight.**) What is the right piece? (**可 kě.**) What is the last stroke? (**The long vertical with a hook.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 河, pinned stroke paths and medians.

442.4 上游 (shàngyóu) — upper reaches (of a river); upstream

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the far bank, then the Mandarin for a river.

You'll want to know: 上游

上游 — *shàngyóu* — "upper reaches (of a river); upstream".

我们坐船去河的上游 *wǒmen zuò chuán qù hé de shàngyóu* — We're taking a boat up the river.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上游 (*shàngyóu*) is built from 上 'above' and 游 'to float', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangH* and *yuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); how the second came to name a stretch of a river is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngyóu*
- *Say it: shàngyóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò chuán qù hé de shàngyóu* — We're taking a boat up the river.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the far bank, then the Mandarin for a river, then say *shàngyóu* again

Before you move on

What does 上游 mean? ("Upper reaches (of a river); upstream".) Say it once more.

442.5 zhǎngshuǐ — to rise after rain (of a river)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a river, then the Mandarin for upstream.

You'll want to know: zhǎngshuǐ

zhǎngshuǐ — "to rise after rain (of a river)".

zhè jǐ tiān xiàyǔ hé lǐ zhǎngshuǐ le — It has rained these last few days, and the river has risen.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: zhǎng is said with a rising tone before shuǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǎngshuǐ is built from *zhǎng* 'to swell' and 水 'water', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjang* and *sywijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a great flood of water; today's falling-rising tone is irregular beside it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎngshuǐ*
- *Say it: zhǎngshuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jǐ tiān xiàyǔ hé lǐ zhǎngshuǐ le* — It has rained these last few days, and the river has risen.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a river, then the Mandarin for upstream, then say *zhǎngshuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does zhǎngshuǐ mean? ("To rise after rain (of a river)".) Say it once more.

442.6 jiāng — a great river; big river

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for upstream, then the Mandarin for to rise after rain.

You'll want to know: jiāng

jiāng — "a great river; big river".

zhè tiáo jiāng bǐ nà tiáo hé cháng — This great river is longer than that one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāng is inherited from Middle Chinese *kaewng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it with the pair 'rivers and seas' and lists the great rivers of the south under it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāng*
- *Say it: jiāng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè tiáo jiāng bǐ nà tiáo hé cháng* — This great river is longer than that one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for upstream, then the Mandarin for to rise after rain, then say *jiāng* again

Before you move on

What does jiāng mean? ("A great river; big river".) Say it once more.

Chapter 443

Keeping It Clean

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the water is clear, protect a river, visit a nature reserve, escort someone and talk about fishing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 443: I can say the water is clear, protect a river, visit a nature reserve, escort someone and talk about fishing.*

443.1 qīngchè — crystal-clear (of water)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to rise after rain, then the Mandarin for a great river.

You'll want to know: qīngchè

qīngchè — "crystal-clear (of water)".

> *zhè tiáo hé de shuǐ hěn qīngchè* — The water in this river is crystal clear.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīngchè is built from *qīng* 'clear' and *chè* 'clear water', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjeng* and *drjet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as water that has settled clear.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīngchè*
- *Say it: qīngchè*, once more
- *Say it: zhè tiáo hé de shuǐ hěn qīngchè* — The water in this river is crystal clear.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to rise after rain, then the Mandarin for a great river, then say *qīngchè* again

Before you move on

What does qīngchè mean? ("Crystal-clear (of water)".) Say it once more.

443.2 保护 (bǎohù) — to protect; to keep from harm

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a great river, then the Mandarin for crystal-clear.

You'll want to know: 保护

保护 — *bǎohù* — "to protect; to keep from harm".

我们应该保护河水 *wǒmen yīnggāi bǎohù héshuǐ* — We should keep the river water clean.

The new character, in pieces: 护 — seven strokes in two pieces: on the left the hand piece of 扌, three strokes; on the right a dot over a frame and a long stroke falling to the left, four strokes, as on top of 房. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

保护 (*bǎohù*) is built from 保 'to keep' and 护 'to guard', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *huH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to keep safe' and the second 'to rescue' and 'to help'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎohù*
- *Say it: bǎohù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen yīnggāi bǎohù héshuǐ* — We should keep the river water clean.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a great river, then the Mandarin for crystal-clear, then say *bǎohù* again

Before you move on

What does 保护 mean? ("To protect; to keep from harm".) Say it once more.

443.3 护 — the hand piece, then the top of 房

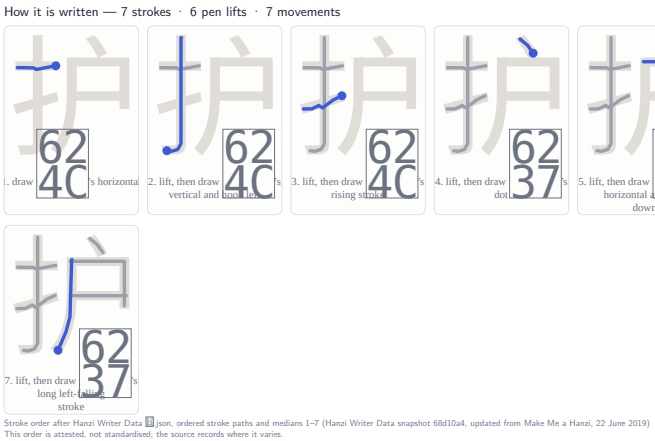
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bǎohù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  打 房

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dǎ*, *fáng*

Script — the hand piece, then the top of 房



How 护 is written, stroke by stroke

护

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the hand piece, three strokes, as in 打: a bar, a vertical with a hook, and a stroke that rises to the right through the vertical.

The right piece, four strokes, as on top of 房: a dot; a stroke that runs right and turns down; a bar that closes the frame at the foot; then a long stroke falling to the left from the top corner of the frame.

3 + 4 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 护, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 护? (**Seven.**) What is the left piece? (**The hand piece, as in 打.**) Where have you made the right piece before? (**On top of 房.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 护, pinned stroke paths and medians.

443.4 保护区 (bǎohùqū) — nature reserve; protected area

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for crystal-clear, then the Mandarin for to keep from harm.

You'll want to know: 保护区

保护区 — *bǎohùqū* — "nature reserve; protected area".

> 我们坐车去山里的保护区 *wǒmen zuò chē qù shān lǐ de bǎohùqū* — We're driving to the nature reserve in the mountains.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

保护区 (*bǎohùqū*) is built from 保护 'to protect' and 区 'an area', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX*, *huH* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎohùqū*
- *Say it: bǎohùqū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò chē qù shān lǐ de bǎohùqū* — We're driving to the nature reserve in the mountains.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for crystal-clear, then the Mandarin for to keep from harm, then say *bǎohùqū* again

Before you move on

What does 保护区 mean? ("Nature reserve; protected area".) Say it once more.

443.5 护送 (hùsòng) — to escort

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to keep from harm, then the Mandarin for a nature reserve.

You'll want to know: 护送

护送 — *hùsòng* — "to escort".

tiān hēi le cūnzhǎng hùsòng wǒmen guò hé — It got dark, so the village head saw us safely across the river.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

护送 (*hùsòng*) is built from 护 'to guard' and 送 'to see someone off', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huH* and *suwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to send'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hùsòng*
- *Say it: hùsòng*, once more
- *Say it: tiān hēi le cūnzhǎng hùsòng wǒmen guò hé* — It got dark, so the village head saw us safely across the river.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to keep from harm, then the Mandarin for a nature reserve, then say *hùsòng* again

Before you move on

What does 护送 mean? ("To escort".) Say it once more.

443.6 bǔyú — to catch fish (for a living)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a nature reserve, then the Mandarin for to escort someone.

You'll want to know: bǔyú

bǔyú — "to catch fish (for a living)".

> *cūnmín měitiān zuò chuán qù bǔyú* — The villagers go out fishing by boat every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǔyú is built from *bǔ* 'to seize' and *yú* 'a fish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *buH* and *ngjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to seize'; the falling-rising bǔ is irregular beside it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǔyú*
- *Say it: bǔyú*, once more
- *Say it: cūnmín měitiān zuò chuán qù bǔyú* — The villagers go out fishing by boat every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a nature reserve, then the Mandarin for to escort someone, then say *bǔyú* again

Before you move on

What does bǔyú mean? ("To catch fish (for a living)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 444

An Island

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about diving, an island, a peninsula, a lighthouse and sunscreen.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 444: I can talk about diving, an island, a peninsula, a lighthouse and sunscreen.*

444.1 qiánshuǐ — to go diving; to dive under water

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to escort someone, then the Mandarin for to catch fish.

You'll want to know: qiánshuǐ

qiánshuǐ — "to go diving; to dive under water".

> *xiàtiān wǒmen qù hǎibiān qiánshuǐ* — In summer we go diving at the seaside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiánshuǐ is built from *qián* 'to go under' and 水 'water', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjem* and *sywijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as water flowing hidden and 'to

hide’.

What you’ve built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiánshuǐ*
- *Say it: qiánshuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: xiàtiān wǒmen qù hǎibiān qiánshuǐ* — In summer we go diving at the seaside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to escort someone, then the Mandarin for to catch fish, then say *qiánshuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does qiánshuǐ mean? (“To go diving; to dive under water”.) Say it once more.

444.2 岛 (dǎo) — island

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to catch fish, then the Mandarin for to dive under water.

You’ll want to know: 岛

岛 — *dǎo* — “island”.

我们坐船去那个岛 *wǒmen zuò chuán qù nàge dǎo* — We’re taking a boat to that island.

The new character, in pieces: 岛 — seven strokes in two pieces: on top a short stroke falling to the left, a small bar that turns down and hooks, a dot inside it, and a long stroke that runs down, turns right, turns down again and hooks; tucked under it 山 shān, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

岛 (*dǎo*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *tawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it, after an older dictionary, as the hills here and there in the sea where one can stop and rest.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎo*
- *Say it: dǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò chuán qù nàge dǎo* — We're taking a boat to that island.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to catch fish, then the Mandarin for to dive under water, then say *dǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 岛 mean? ("Island".) Say it once more.

444.3 岛 — a top piece of four strokes, then 山

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *dǎo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  山 海

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shān*, *hǎi*

Script — a top piece of four strokes, then 山

How 岛 is written, stroke by stroke

岛

Two pieces, top before bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, four strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A small bar that turns down and hooks. A dot inside it. Then a long stroke that runs down the left, turns right along the foot, turns down again and ends in a hook.

The bottom piece, 山 shān, three strokes, tucked into the corner: the middle vertical first, then the left one, which turns right along the foot, then the right one.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 岛, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 岛? (**Seven**.) Which written character sits at the bottom? (山.) Which stroke of 山 comes first? (**The middle vertical**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 岛, pinned stroke paths and medians.

444.4 半岛 (bàndǎo) — peninsula

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dive under water, then the Mandarin for an island.

You'll want to know: 半岛

半岛 — *bàndǎo* — "peninsula".

这个半岛有很多酒店 *zhège bàndǎo yǒu hěn duō jiǔdiàn* — There are lots of hotels on this peninsula.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

半岛 (*bàndǎo*) is built from 半 'half' and 岛 'an island', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *panH* and *tawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàndǎo*
- *Say it: bàndǎo*, once more
- *Say it: zhège bàndǎo yǒu hěn duō jiǔdiàn* — There are lots of hotels on this peninsula.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dive under water, then the Mandarin for an island, then say *bàndǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 半岛 mean? ("Peninsula".) Say it once more.

444.5 dēngtǎ — lighthouse

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an island, then the Mandarin for a peninsula.

You'll want to know: dēngtǎ

dēngtǎ — "lighthouse".

wǎnshang chuán wǎng dēngtǎ kāi — At night the boats steer for the lighthouse.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dēngtǎ is built from *dēng* 'a lamp' and *tǎ* 'a tower', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tong* and *thap* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a lamp and the second as a pagoda.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: dēngtǎ*
- *Say it: dēngtǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang chuán wǎng dēngtǎ kāi* — At night the boats steer for the lighthouse.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an island, then the Mandarin for a peninsula, then say *dēngtǎ* again

Before you move on

What does dēngtǎ mean? (“Lighthouse”.) Say it once more.

444.6 fángshàishuāng — sunscreen

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a peninsula, then the Mandarin for a lighthouse.

You’ll want to know: fángshàishuāng

fángshàishuāng — “sunscreen”.

wǒ de fángshàishuāng bú jiàn le — My sunscreen has gone missing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fángshàishuāng is built from *fáng* ’to guard against’, *shài* ’to put in the sun’ and *shuāng* ’frost’, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjang*, *sreaH* and *srjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription); the sense ’a cream’ for the last is modern.

What you’ve built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fángshàishuāng*
- *Say it: fángshàishuāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de fángshàishuāng bú jiàn le* — My sunscreen has gone missing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a peninsula, then the Mandarin for a lighthouse, then say *fángshàishuāng* again

Before you move on

What does fángshàishuāng mean? (“Sunscreen”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 445

By the Sea

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the waves, fishing boats, going ashore, shells and the tide going out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 445: I can talk about the waves, fishing boats, going ashore, shells and the tide going out.*

445.1 hǎilàng — sea wave; a wave of the sea

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a lighthouse, then the Mandarin for sunscreen.

You'll want to know: hǎilàng

hǎilàng — "sea wave; a wave of the sea".

> *hǎilàng tài dà le chuán kāi bu dào nàge dǎo* — The waves are too big: the boat can't get to the island.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎilàng is built from 海 'the sea' and *làng* 'a wave', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xojX* and *langH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'waves'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎilàng*
- *Say it: hǎilàng*, once more
- *Say it: hǎilàng tài dà le chuán kāi bu dào nàge dǎo* — The waves are too big: the boat can't get to the island.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a lighthouse, then the Mandarin for sunscreen, then say *hǎilàng* again

Before you move on

What does hǎilàng mean? ("Sea wave; a wave of the sea".) Say it once more.

445.2 yúchuán — fishing boat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sunscreen, then the Mandarin for a wave of the sea.

You'll want to know: yúchuán

yúchuán — "fishing boat".

měitiān zǎoshang hěn duō yúchuán chūhǎi — Every morning lots of fishing boats go out to sea.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yúchuán is built from *yú* 'fishing' and 船 'a boat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjo* and *zywen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, as catching fish. It is the syllable of *yú* 'a fish', written with the water piece.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yúchuán*
- *Say it: yúchuán*, once more
- *Say it: měitiān zǎoshang hěn duō yúchuán chūhǎi* — Every morning lots of fishing boats go out to sea.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sunscreen, then the Mandarin for a wave of the sea, then say *yúchuán* again

Before you move on

What does yúchuán mean? ("Fishing boat".) Say it once more.

445.3 shàng'àn — to go ashore

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a wave of the sea, then the Mandarin for a fishing boat.

You'll want to know: shàng'àn

shàng'àn — "to go ashore".

xiàwǔ sì diǎn wǒmen shàng'àn zuò chē huí jiǔdiàn — At four in the afternoon we go ashore and take the bus back to the hotel.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shàng'àn is built from 上 'to go up' and *àn* 'a bank', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *nganH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to climb' and the second as the high edge of the water.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàng'àn*
- *Say it: shàng'àn*, once more
- *Say it: xiàwǔ sì diǎn wǒmen shàng'àn zuò chē huí jiǔdiàn* — At four in the afternoon we go ashore and take the bus back to the hotel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a wave of the sea, then the Mandarin for a fishing boat, then say *shàng'àn* again

Before you move on

What does shàng'àn mean? ("To go ashore".) Say it once more.

445.4 bèiké — seashell

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a fishing boat, then the Mandarin for to go ashore.

You'll want to know: bèiké

bèiké — "seashell".

wǒ zhǎodào le hěn duō bèiké fàng zài bāo lǐ — I found lots of shells and put them in my bag.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bèiké is built from *bèi* 'a shellfish' and *ké* 'a hard shell'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *pajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as a creature of the sea in a shell; the second is in the Guangyun only under an older spelling, read *khaewk* and glossed 'a hard skin', and the everyday *ké* does not follow from that reading, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bèiké*
- *Say it: bèiké*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhǎodào le hěn duō bèiké fàng zài bāo lǐ* — I found lots of shells and put them in my bag.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a fishing boat, then the Mandarin for to go ashore, then say *bèiké* again

Before you move on

What does bèiké mean? ("Seashell".) Say it once more.

445.5 tuìcháo — to ebb (of the tide)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go ashore, then the Mandarin for a seashell.

You'll want to know: tuìcháo

tuìcháo — "to ebb (of the tide)".

xiàwǔ tuìcháo de shíhou wǒmen qù hǎibiān zhǎo bèiké — In the afternoon, when the tide goes out, we look for shells on the shore.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuìcháo is built from *tuì* 'to draw back' and *cháo* 'the tide', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwojH* and *drjew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to retreat' and the second as the tide.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuìcháo*
- *Say it: tuìcháo*, once more
- *Say it: xiàwǔ tuìcháo de shíhou wǒmen qù hǎibiān zhǎo bèiké* — In the afternoon, when the tide goes out, we look for shells on the shore.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go ashore, then the Mandarin for a seashell, then say *tuìcháo* again

Before you move on

What does tuìcháo mean? ("To ebb (of the tide)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 446

The Old Town

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about old lanes, a walled town, an ancient town, its walls and moving to the city for work.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 446: I can talk about old lanes, a walled town, an ancient town, its walls and moving to the city for work.*

446.1 hútòng — lane; alley (in an old city)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a seashell, then the Mandarin for to ebb.

You'll want to know: hútòng

hútòng — "lane; alley (in an old city)".

> *wǒ zhù zài yì tiáo xiǎo hútòng lǐ* — I live in a little old lane.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hútòng names the narrow lanes of old northern cities. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hútòng*
- *Say it: hútòng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhù zài yì tiáo xiǎo hútòng lǐ* — I live in a little old lane.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a seashell, then the Mandarin for to ebb, then say *hútòng* again

Before you move on

What does hútòng mean? ("Lane; alley (in an old city)".) Say it once more.

446.2 城 (chéng) — town; walled city

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ebb, then the Mandarin for a narrow old lane.

You'll want to know: 城

城 — *chéng* — "town; walled city".

城里有很多老房子 *chéng lǐ yǒu hěn duō lǎo fángzi* — There are lots of old houses in the town.

The new character, in pieces: 城 — nine strokes in two pieces: on the left the earth piece of 地, three strokes; on the right 成 chéng, six strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

城 (*chéng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses it as the walls of a city and, after an older book, as what holds the people and their goods.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéng*
- *Say it: chéng*, once more
- *Say it: chéng lǐ yǒu hěn duō lǎo fángzi* — There are lots of old houses in the town.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ebb, then the Mandarin for a narrow old lane, then say *chéng* again

Before you move on

What does 城 mean? ("Town; walled city".) Say it once more.

446.3 城 — the earth piece, then 成

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *chéng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  地 成

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *dì*, *chéng*

Script — the earth piece, then 成

How 城 *is written, stroke by stroke*

城

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the earth piece, three strokes, as on the left of 地: a short bar, a vertical, and a stroke that rises to the right.

The right piece, 成 chéng, six strokes, as you wrote it: a bar; a long stroke falling to the left; a small bar that turns down and hooks; the long curved stroke with a hook; a short stroke falling to the left across it; and a dot at the top right.

3 + 6 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 城, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 城? (**Nine.**) What is the left piece? (**The earth piece, as in 地.**) What is the right piece? (**成 chéng.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 城, pinned stroke paths and medians.

446.4 古城 (gǔchéng) — ancient walled town; old town

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a narrow old lane, then the Mandarin for a walled town.

You'll want to know: 古城

古城 — *gǔchéng* — "ancient walled town; old town".

我们在古城里走了一个下午 *wǒmen zài gǔchéng lǐ zǒu le yí ge xiàwǔ* — We spent the afternoon walking round the old town.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

古城 (*gǔchéng*) is built from 古 'ancient' and 城 'a walled town', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔchéng*
- *Say it: gǔchéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài gǔchéng lǐ zǒu le yí ge xiàwǔ* — We spent the afternoon walking round the old town.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a narrow old lane, then the Mandarin for a walled town, then say *gǔchéng* again

Before you move on

What does 古城 mean? ("Ancient walled town; old town".) Say it once more.

446.5 chéngqiáng — city wall; the wall round a city

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a walled town, then the Mandarin for an ancient walled town.

You'll want to know: chéngqiáng

chéngqiáng — "city wall; the wall round a city".

qù chéngqiáng zěnme zǒu — How do I get to the city wall?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngqiáng is built from 城 'a walled town' and *qiáng* 'a wall', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *dzjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngqiáng*
- *Say it: chéngqiáng*, once more
- *Say it: qù chéngqiáng zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the city wall?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a walled town, then the Mandarin for an ancient walled town, then say *chéngqiáng* again

Before you move on

What does chéngqiáng mean? ("City wall; the wall round a city".) Say it once more.

446.6 进城 (jìnchéng) — to go to town; to move to the city

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an ancient walled town, then the Mandarin for the wall round a city.

You'll want to know: 进城

进城 — *jìnchéng* — "to go to town; to move to the city".

村子里很多人进城打工 *cūnzi lǐ hěn duō rén jìnchéng dǎgōng* — A lot of people from the village move to the city for work.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

进城 (*jìnchéng*) is built from 进 'to enter' and 城 'a walled town', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsinH* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go forward'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnchéng*
- *Say it: jìnchéng*, once more
- *Say it: cūnzi lǐ hěn duō rén jìnchéng dǎgōng* — A lot of people from the village move to the city for work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an ancient walled town, then the Mandarin for the wall round a city, then say *jìnchéng* again

Before you move on

What does 进城 mean? ("To go to town; to move to the city".) Say it once more.

Chapter 447

On Foot

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about walking, the Great Wall, a pedestrian street, going the long way round and the pavement.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 447: I can talk about walking, the Great Wall, a pedestrian street, going the long way round and the pavement.*

447.1 bùxíng — to get there on foot

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the wall round a city, then the Mandarin for to move to the city.

You'll want to know: bùxíng

bùxíng — "to get there on foot".

> *cóng jiǔdiàn bùxíng qù gǔchéng yào shí fēnzhōng* — It's a ten-minute walk from the hotel to the old town.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bùxíng is built from *bù* 'a step' and *xíng* 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *buH* and *haeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a walking step and the second 'to walk'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùxíng*
- *Say it: bùxíng*, once more
- *Say it: cóng jiǔdiàn bùxíng qù gǔchéng yào shí fēnzhōng* — It's a ten-minute walk from the hotel to the old town.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the wall round a city, then the Mandarin for to move to the city, then say *bùxíng* again

Before you move on

What does bùxíng mean? ("To get there on foot".) Say it once more.

447.2 长城 (Chángchéng) — the Great Wall

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to move to the city, then the Mandarin for to get there on foot.

You'll want to know: 长城

长城 — *Chángchéng* — "the Great Wall".

我们坐车去长城 *wǒmen zuò chē qù Chángchéng* — We're going to the great wall by bus.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

长城 (*Chángchéng*) is built from 长 'long' and 城 'a wall round a city', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjang* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'long' and 'far'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: Chángchéng*
- *Say it: Chángchéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zuò chē qù Chángchéng* — We're going to the great wall by bus.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to move to the city, then the Mandarin for to get there on foot, then say *Chángchéng* again

Before you move on

What does 长城 mean? ("The Great Wall".) Say it once more.

447.3 bùxíngjiē — pedestrian street; a street closed to cars

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get there on foot, then the Mandarin for the Great Wall.

You'll want to know: bùxíngjiē

bùxíngjiē — "pedestrian street; a street closed to cars".

qù bùxíngjiē zěnme zǒu — How do I get to the pedestrian street?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bùxíngjiē is built from *bùxíng* 'on foot' and *jiē* 'a street', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *buH*, *haeng* and *kea* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last as a road that runs four ways.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùxíngjiē*
- *Say it: bùxíngjiē*, once more
- *Say it: qù bùxíngjiē zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the pedestrian street?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get there on foot, then the Mandarin for the Great Wall, then say *bùxíngjiē* again

Before you move on

What does bùxíngjiē mean? ("Pedestrian street; a street closed to cars".) Say it once more.

447.4 ràolù — to take a detour; to take the long way round

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the Great Wall, then the Mandarin for a street closed to cars.

You'll want to know: ràolù

ràolù — "to take a detour; to take the long way round".

qiánbian zài xiū lù wǒmen děi ràolù — There are roadworks ahead, so we'll have to go the long way round.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ràolù is built from *rào* 'to wind round' and 路 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyewX* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to wind round'; today's falling tone is irregular beside it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: ràolù*
- *Say it: ràolù*, once more
- *Say it: qiánbian zài xiū lù wǒmen děi ràolù* — There are roadworks ahead, so we'll have to go the long way round.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the Great Wall, then the Mandarin for a street closed to cars, then say *ràolù* again

Before you move on

What does ràolù mean? ("To take a detour; to take the long way round".) Say it once more.

447.5 rénxíngdào — pavement; sidewalk

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a street closed to cars, then the Mandarin for to take the long way round.

You'll want to know: rénxíngdào

rénxíngdào — "pavement; sidewalk".

> *qǐng zǒu rénxíngdào bié zǒu mǎlù* — Please keep to the pavement and stay off the road.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rénxíngdào is built from 人 'people', *xíng* 'to walk' and 道 'a way', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyin*, *haeng* and *dawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: rénxíngdào*
- *Say it: rénxíngdào*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng zǒu rénxíngdào bié zǒu mǎlù* — Please keep to the pavement and stay off the road.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a street closed to cars, then the Mandarin for to take the long way round, then say *rénxíngdào* again

Before you move on

What does rénxíngdào mean? ("Pavement; sidewalk".) Say it once more.

447.6 Looking back: from The River to On Foot

Say the Mandarin for the far bank and a river.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the far bank, a river, upstream, to rise after rain, a great river
- *Say it:* crystal-clear, to keep from harm, a nature reserve, to escort someone, to catch fish
- *Say it:* to dive under water, an island, a peninsula, a lighthouse, sunscreen
- *Say it:* a wave of the sea, a fishing boat, to go ashore, a seashell, to ebb
- *Say it:* a narrow old lane, a walled town, an ancient walled town, the wall round a city, to move to the city
- *Say it:* to get there on foot, the Great Wall, a street closed to cars, to take the long way round, the pavement beside the road
- *Read it:* 河 护 岛 城 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The far bank? (*duì'àn.*) A river? (河, *hé.*) Upstream? (上游, *shàngyóu.*) To rise after rain? (*zhǎngshuǐ.*) A great river? (*jiāng.*) Crystal-clear? (*qīngchè.*) To keep from harm? (保护, *bǎohù.*) A nature reserve? (保护区, *bǎohùqū.*) To escort someone? (护送, *hùsòng.*) To catch fish? (*bǔyú.*) To dive under water? (*qiánshuǐ.*) An island? (岛, *dǎo.*) A peninsula? (半岛, *bàndǎo.*) A lighthouse? (*dēngtǎ.*) Sunscreen? (*fángshàishuāng.*) A wave of the sea? (*hǎilàng.*) A fishing boat? (*yúchuán.*) To go ashore? (*shàng'àn.*) A seashell? (*bèiké.*) To ebb? (*tuìcháo.*) A narrow old lane? (*hútòng.*) A walled town? (城, *chéng.*) An ancient walled town? (古城, *gǔchéng.*) The wall round a city? (*chéngqiáng.*) To move to the city? (进城, *jìnchéng.*) To get there on foot? (*bùxíng.*) The Great Wall? (长城, *Chángchéng.*) A street closed to cars? (*bùxíngjiē.*) To take the long way round? (*ràolù.*) The pavement beside the road? (*rénxíngdào.*)

Chapter 448

At the Market

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about stalls, find the market, stay in town, go to a morning market and run a stall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 448: I can talk about stalls, find the market, stay in town, go to a morning market and run a stall.*

448.1 tānwèi — market stall

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take the long way round, then the Mandarin for the pavement beside the road.

You'll want to know: tānwèi

tānwèi — "market stall".

> *zhège tānwèi mài shuǐguǒ* — This stall sells fruit.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tānwèi is built from *tān* 'to spread out' and *wèi* 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *than* and *hwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to open out' and the second as a place in a row.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tānwèi*
- *Say it: tānwèi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège tānwèi mài shuǐguǒ* — This stall sells fruit.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take the long way round, then the Mandarin for the pavement beside the road, then say *tānwèi* again

Before you move on

What does tānwèi mean? ("Market stall".) Say it once more.

448.2 市场 (shìchǎng) — market; marketplace

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the pavement beside the road, then the Mandarin for a market stall.

You'll want to know: 市场

市场 — *shìchǎng* — "market; marketplace".

去市场怎么走 *qù shìchǎng zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the market?

The new character, in pieces: 市 — five strokes: a dot, a long bar, then a short vertical, a stroke that turns down and hooks, and a long vertical through the middle. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

市场 (*shìchǎng*) is built from 市 'a market' and 场 'an open ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyiX* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, as where people go to buy and sell, and the second as a threshing floor.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìchǎng*
- *Say it: shìchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: qù shìchǎng zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the market?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the pavement beside the road, then the Mandarin for a market stall, then say *shìchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 市场 mean? ("Market; marketplace".) Say it once more.

448.3 市 — a dot and a bar over three strokes

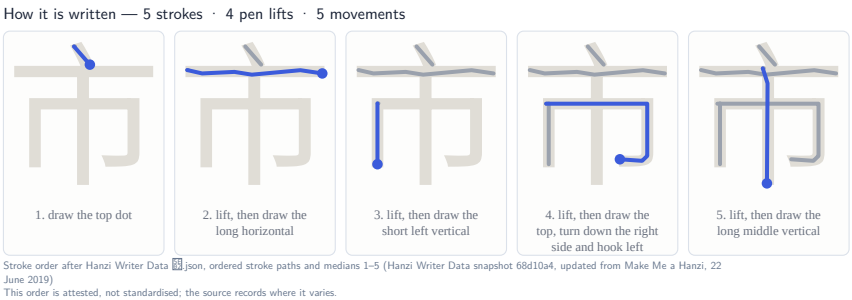
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shìchǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  场 方

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *chǎng*, *fāng*

Script — a dot and a bar over three strokes



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 市.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–5 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 市 is written, stroke by stroke

市

One piece, five strokes, top to bottom.
A dot on top, then a long bar, as at the top of 方.
Under the bar, three strokes like a small hanging cloth. A short vertical on the left. A stroke that runs right and turns down, hooking to the left at the foot. Then a long vertical through the middle, from the bar down past the hook.
2 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 市, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 市? (**Five**.) What comes first? (**A dot**.) What is the last stroke? (**The long vertical through the middle**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 市, pinned stroke paths and medians.

448.4 市区 (shìqū) — the built-up part of a city; downtown

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a market stall, then the Mandarin for a marketplace.

You'll want to know: 市区

市区 — *shìqū* — "the built-up part of a city; downtown".

wǒmen zhù zài shìqū de yì jiā jiǔdiàn — We're staying at a hotel in town.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

市区 (*shìqū*) is built from 市 'a market town' and 区 'an area', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyiX* and *khju* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìqū*
- *Say it: shìqū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhù zài shìqū de yì jiā jiǔdiàn* — We're staying at a hotel in town.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a market stall, then the Mandarin for a marketplace, then say *shìqū* again

Before you move on

What does 市区 mean? ("The built-up part of a city; downtown".) Say it once more.

448.5 早市 (zǎoshì) — morning market; a market held at dawn

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a marketplace, then the Mandarin for the built-up part of a city.

You'll want to know: 早市

早市 — *zǎoshì* — "morning market; a market held at dawn".

我们早上去早市买菜 *wǒmen zǎoshang qù zǎoshì mǎi cài* — In the morning we go to the early market to buy vegetables.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

早市 (*zǎoshì*) is built from 早 'early' and 市 'a market', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsawX* and *dzyiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the morning'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǎoshì*
- *Say it: zǎoshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zǎoshang qù zǎoshì mǎi cài* — In the morning we go to the early market to buy vegetables.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a marketplace, then the Mandarin for the built-up part of a city, then say *zǎoshì* again

Before you move on

What does 早市 mean? ("Morning market; a market held at dawn".) Say it once more.

448.6 bǎitān — to set up a street stall

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the built-up part of a city, then the Mandarin for a market held at dawn.

You'll want to know: bǎitān

bǎitān — "to set up a street stall".

tā měitiān zài shìchǎng bǎitān — He runs a stall at the market every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎitān is built from *bǎi* 'to set out' and *tān* 'to spread out', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *peaX* and *than* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to push aside' and the second 'to open out'; the sense 'to set out goods' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎitān*
- *Say it: bǎitān*, once more
- *Say it: tā měitiān zài shìchǎng bǎitān* — He runs a stall at the market every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the built-up part of a city, then the Mandarin for a market held at dawn, then say *bǎitān* again

Before you move on

What does bǎitān mean? ("To set up a street stall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 449

Tastes

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a night market, tastes in food, local flavours, light food and greasy food.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 449: I can talk about a night market, tastes in food, local flavours, light food and greasy food.*

449.1 yèshì — night market

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a market held at dawn, then the Mandarin for to set up a street stall.

You'll want to know: yèshì

yèshì — "night market".

> *wǎnshang wǒmen zuò gōngjiāo qù yèshì* — In the evening we take the bus to the night market.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yèshì is built from *yè* 'night' and 市 'a market', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yaeH* and *dzyiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yèshì*
- *Say it: yèshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǎnshang wǒmen zuò gōngjiāo qù yèshì* — In the evening we take the bus to the night market.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a market held at dawn, then the Mandarin for to set up a street stall, then say *yèshì* again

Before you move on

What does yèshì mean? ("Night market".) Say it once more.

449.2 口味 (kǒuwèi) — one's taste in food

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to set up a street stall, then the Mandarin for a night market.

You'll want to know: 口味

口味 — *kǒuwèi* — "one's taste in food".

nánfāng rén hé běifāng rén de kǒuwèi bù yíyàng — People in the south and the north have different tastes in food.

The new character, in pieces: 味 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left 口 kǒu, small; on the right a short bar, a longer bar under it, a vertical through both, and a stroke falling to the left and one falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

口味 (*kǒuwèi*) is built from 口 'the mouth' and 味 'a flavour', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khuwX* and *mj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the five flavours,

sour, salty, sweet, bitter and pungent.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǒuwèi*
- *Say it: kǒuwèi*, once more
- *Say it: nánfāng rén hé běifāng rén de kǒuwèi bù yíyàng* — People in the south and the north have different tastes in food.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to set up a street stall, then the Mandarin for a night market, then say *kǒuwèi* again

Before you move on

What does 口味 mean? ("One's taste in food".) Say it once more.

449.3 味 — a small 口, then two bars and a vertical

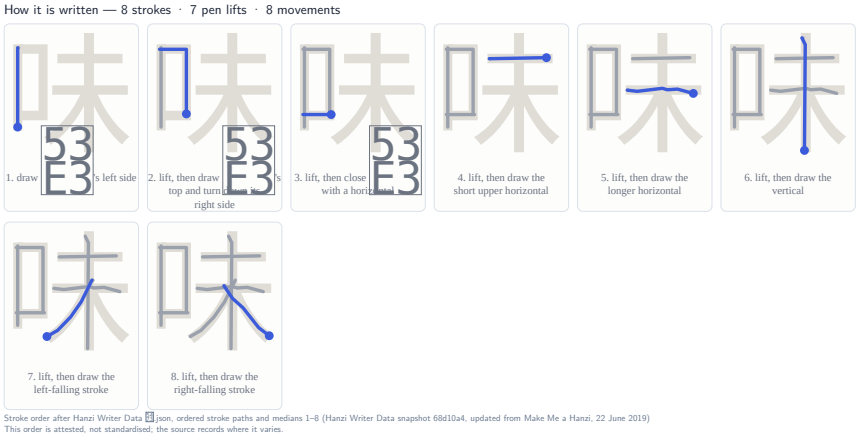
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kǒuwèi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  口 吃

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *chī*

Script — a small 口, then two bars and a vertical



How 味 *is written, stroke by stroke*

味

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 口 kǒu, three strokes, small and set high.

The right piece, five strokes. A short bar. A longer bar under it. A vertical down through both. Then a stroke falling to the left and a stroke falling to the right, from where the vertical crosses the long bar.

3 + 5 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 味, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 味? (**Eight**.) Which bar is shorter, the top one or the one under it? (**The top one**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 味, pinned stroke paths and medians.

449.4 风味 (fēngwèi) — local flavour; distinctive taste

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a night market, then the Mandarin for one's taste in food.

You'll want to know: 风味

风味 — *fēngwèi* — "local flavour; distinctive taste".

我想吃这个岛的风味小吃 *wǒ xiǎng chī zhège dǎo de fēngwèi xiǎochī* — I'd like to try this island's local snacks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

风味 (*fēngwèi*) is built from 风 'a custom' and 味 'a flavour', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjuwng* and *mj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the sense 'a local custom' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fēngwèi*
- *Say it: fēngwèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng chī zhège dǎo de fēngwèi xiǎochī* — I'd like to try this island's local snacks.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a night market, then the Mandarin for one's taste in food, then say *fēngwèi* again

Before you move on

What does 风味 mean? ("Local flavour; distinctive taste".) Say it once more.

449.5 qīngdàn — light and mild (of food)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's taste in food, then the Mandarin for a distinctive local flavour.

You'll want to know: qīngdàn

qīngdàn — "light and mild (of food)".

zhè jiā fànguǎn de cài hěn qīngdàn — The food at this restaurant is light.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīngdàn is built from *qīng* 'clear' and *dàn* 'thin', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjeng* and *damX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a thin taste.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīngdàn*
- *Say it: qīngdàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fànguǎn de cài hěn qīngdàn* — The food at this restaurant is light.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's taste in food, then the Mandarin for a distinctive local flavour, then say *qīngdàn* again

Before you move on

What does qīngdàn mean? ("Light and mild (of food)".) Say it once more.

449.6 yóunì — greasy; oily

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a distinctive local flavour, then the Mandarin for light and mild (of food).

You'll want to know: yóunì

yóunì — "greasy; oily".

> *yèshì de dōngxi tài yóunì le* — The food at the night market is too greasy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóunì is built from *yóu* 'oil' and *nì* 'fatty', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *nrijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as oil and fat and the second as fat and greasy.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóunì*
- *Say it: yóunì*, once more
- *Say it: yèshì de dōngxi tài yóunì le* — The food at the night market is too greasy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a distinctive local flavour, then the Mandarin for light and mild (of food), then say *yóunì* again

Before you move on

What does yóunì mean? ("Greasy; oily".) Say it once more.

Chapter 450

Local Food

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about seafood, what makes the food special, going somewhere on purpose, authentic food and a signature dish.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 450: I can talk about seafood, what makes the food special, going somewhere on purpose, authentic food and a signature dish.*

450.1 hǎixiān — seafood

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for light and mild (of food), then the Mandarin for greasy (of food).

You'll want to know: hǎixiān

hǎixiān — "seafood".

> *zhè jiā fànguǎn de hǎixiān hěn xīnxiān* — The seafood at this restaurant is very fresh.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎixiān is built from 海 'the sea' and *xiān* 'fresh', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xojX* and *sjen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'fresh' and 'clean'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎixiān*
- *Say it: hǎixiān*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fànguǎn de hǎixiān hěn xīnxiān* — The seafood at this restaurant is very fresh.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for light and mild (of food), then the Mandarin for greasy (of food), then say *hǎixiān* again

Before you move on

What does hǎixiān mean? ("Seafood".) Say it once more.

450.2 特点 (tèdiǎn) — characteristic; a distinguishing trait

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for greasy (of food), then the Mandarin for seafood.

You'll want to know: 特点

特点 — *tèdiǎn* — "characteristic; a distinguishing trait".

这儿的菜有什么特点 *zhèr de cài yǒu shénme tèdiǎn* — What's special about the food here?

The new character, in pieces: 特 — ten strokes in two pieces: on the left the cow piece, four strokes; on the right the earth piece of 地 over the right piece of 对. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

特点 (*tèdiǎn*) is built from 特 'single, special' and 点 'a point', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dok* and *temX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a bull and 'alone' and the

second as a dot made with the brush.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tèdiǎn*
- *Say it: tèdiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de cài yǒu shénme tèdiǎn* — What's special about the food here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for greasy (of food), then the Mandarin for seafood, then say *tèdiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 特点 mean? ("Characteristic; a distinguishing trait".) Say it once more.

450.3 特 — the cow piece, then two pieces stacked

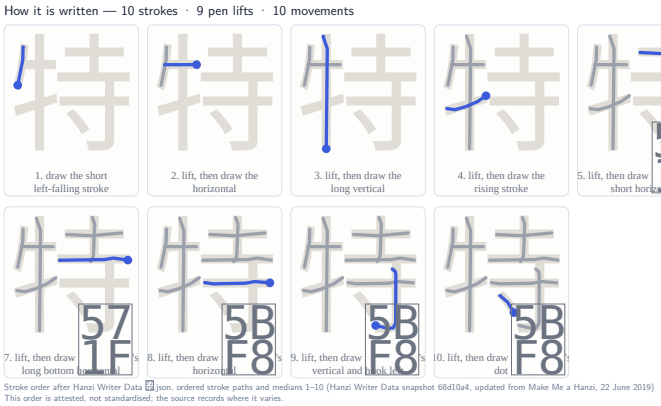
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tèdiǎn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

对 地

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *duì*, *dì*

Script — the cow piece, then two pieces stacked



How 特 *is written, stroke by stroke*

特

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the cow piece, four strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A bar. A long vertical down through the bar. Then a stroke that rises to the right.

The right piece, six strokes, in two parts. On top, the earth piece of 地 with its last bar long: a short bar, a vertical, and a long bar under them. Under it, the right piece of 对: a bar, a vertical with a hook, and a dot.

4 + 6 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 特, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 特? (**Ten.**) What is the last stroke of the left piece? (**A stroke that rises to the right.**) What sits at the foot of the right piece? (**The right piece of 对.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 特, pinned stroke paths and medians.

450.4 特意 (tèyì) — specially; for that very purpose

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for seafood, then the Mandarin for a distinguishing trait.

You'll want to know: 特意

特意 — *tèyì* — "specially; for that very purpose".

我们特意去吃这儿的风味小吃 *wǒmen tèyì qù chī zhèr de fēngwèi xiǎochī* — We went specially to try the local snacks here.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

特意 (*tèyì*) is built from 特 'single' and 意 'an intention', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dok* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the will'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tèyì*
- *Say it: tèyì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen tèyì qù chī zhèr de fēngwèi xiǎochī* — We went specially to try the local snacks here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for seafood, then the Mandarin for a distinguishing trait, then say *tèyì* again

Before you move on

What does 特意 mean? ("Specially; for that very purpose".) Say it once more.

450.5 zhèngzōng — authentic; the real thing (of food)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a distinguishing trait, then the Mandarin for specially for that reason.

You'll want to know: zhèngzōng

zhèngzōng — "authentic; the real thing (of food)".

zhè jiā fànguǎn de cài hěn zhèngzōng — The food at this restaurant is authentic.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhèngzōng is built from 正 'right' and *zōng* 'the source', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengH* and *tsowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the origin' and 'to honour'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngzōng*
- *Say it: zhèngzōng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fànguǎn de cài hěn zhèngzōng* — The food at this restaurant is authentic.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a distinguishing trait, then the Mandarin for specially for that reason, then say *zhèngzōng* again

Before you move on

What does zhèngzōng mean? ("Authentic; the real thing (of food)".) Say it once more.

450.6 zhāopáicài — a restaurant's signature dish

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for specially for that reason, then the Mandarin for authentic.

You'll want to know: zhāopáicài

zhāopáicài — "a restaurant's signature dish".

> *zhè shì zhè jiā fànguǎn de zhāopáicài* — This is the restaurant's signature dish.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhāopáicài is built from *zhāopái* 'a shop sign' and 菜 'a dish', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyew*, *bea* and *tshojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to beckon' and the second as a board with writing on it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhāopáicài*
- *Say it: zhāopáicài*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì zhè jiā fànguǎn de zhāopáicài* — This is the restaurant's signature dish.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for specially for that reason, then the Mandarin for authentic, then say *zhāopáicài* again

Before you move on

What does zhāopáicài mean? ("A restaurant's signature dish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 451

Specialities

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I eat no meat, talk about a place's special character, say something is outstanding, ask for meatless dishes and take food that is left over.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 451: I can say I eat no meat, talk about a place's special character, say something is outstanding, ask for meatless dishes and take food that is left over.*

451.1 chīsù — to eat no meat; to be vegetarian

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for authentic, then the Mandarin for a restaurant's signature dish.

You'll want to know: chīsù

chīsù — "to eat no meat; to be vegetarian".

> *wǒ chīsù bù chī ròu* — I'm vegetarian: I don't eat meat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chīsù is built from 吃 'to eat' and *sù* 'plain'. For the first the dictionary has *khek*, glossed 'to eat', under another way of writing it (there 吃 itself is *kj+t*, 'to stammer'), though *khek* would regularly give qì; the second is inherited from Middle Chinese *suH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), glossed as plain white silk, and the sense 'meatless' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chīsù*
- *Say it: chīsù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chīsù bù chī ròu* — I'm vegetarian: I don't eat meat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for authentic, then the Mandarin for a restaurant's signature dish, then say *chīsù* again

Before you move on

What does chīsù mean? ("To eat no meat; to be vegetarian".) Say it once more.

451.2 特色 (tèsè) — special character; speciality

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a restaurant's signature dish, then the Mandarin for to eat no meat.

You'll want to know: 特色

特色 — *tèsè* — "special character; speciality".

zhè jiā fànguǎn de cài hěn yǒu tèsè — The food at this restaurant has a character all its own.

The new character, in pieces: 色 — six strokes in two pieces: on top a short stroke falling to the left and a small bar that turns down to the left; under them a bar that turns down, a short vertical, a bar, and a long stroke that runs down the left, along the foot and hooks up. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

特色 (*tèsè*) is built from 特 'single, special' and 色 'a look', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dok* and *srik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the colour of the face.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tèsè*
- *Say it: tèsè*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fànguǎn de cài hěn yǒu tèsè* — The food at this restaurant has a character all its own.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a restaurant's signature dish, then the Mandarin for to eat no meat, then say *tèsè* again

Before you move on

What does 特色 mean? ("Special character; speciality".) Say it once more.

451.3 色 — a small top piece, then a frame with a long hook

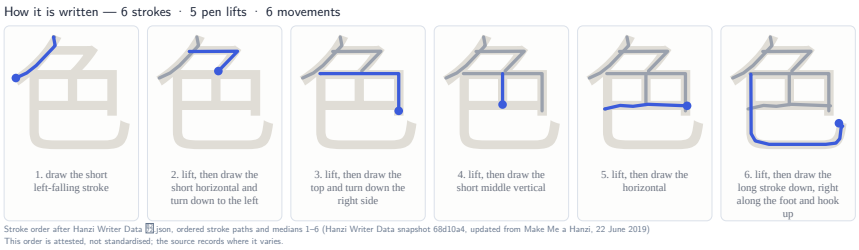
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *tèsè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  包 特

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bāo*, *tè*

Script — a small top piece, then a frame with a long hook



How 色 is written, stroke by stroke

色

Two pieces, top before bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, two strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. Then a small bar that turns down to the left under it.

The bottom piece, four strokes. A bar that turns down on the right. A short vertical in the middle. A bar across under them. Last, a long stroke that runs down the left side, turns right along the foot and hooks up.

2 + 4 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 色, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 色? (**Six.**) What is the last stroke? (**A long stroke down the left that turns along the foot and hooks up.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 色, pinned stroke paths and medians.

451.4 出色 (chūsè) — outstanding; excellent

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to eat no meat, then the Mandarin for a special character of its own.

You'll want to know: 出色

出色 — *chūsè* — "outstanding; excellent".

> 他的中文很出色 *tā de Zhōngwén hěn chūsè* — His spoken Chinese is outstanding.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出色 (*chūsè*) is built from 出 'to stand out' and 色 'a look', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *srik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); how the pair came to mean 'outstanding' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūsè*
- *Say it: chūsè*, once more
- *Say it: tā de Zhōngwén hěn chūsè* — His spoken Chinese is outstanding.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to eat no meat, then the Mandarin for a special character of its own, then say *chūsè* again

Before you move on

What does 出色 mean? ("Outstanding; excellent".) Say it once more.

451.5 sùcài — meatless dish; vegetable dish

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a special character of its own, then the Mandarin for outstanding.

You'll want to know: sùcài

sùcài — "meatless dish; vegetable dish".

> *zhè jiā fànguǎn yǒu hěn duō sùcài* — This restaurant has lots of meatless dishes.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sùcài is built from *sù* 'plain' and 菜 'a dish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *suH* and *tshojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the sense 'meatless' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: sùcài*
- *Say it: sùcài*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fànguǎn yǒu hěn duō sùcài* — This restaurant has lots of meatless dishes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a special character of its own, then the Mandarin for outstanding, then say *sùcài* again

Before you move on

What does sùcài mean? ("Meatless dish; vegetable dish".) Say it once more.

451.6 shèng — to be left over

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for outstanding, then the Mandarin for a meatless dish.

You'll want to know: shèng

shèng — "to be left over".

> *shèng le hěn duō cài wǒmen dǎbāo* — There's a lot of food left, so we'll take it away.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shèng is inherited from Middle Chinese *zyingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as what is long and to spare.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shèng*
- *Say it: shèng*, once more
- *Say it: shèng le hěn duō cài wǒmen dǎbāo* — There's a lot of food left, so we'll take it away.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for outstanding, then the Mandarin for a meatless dish, then say *shèng* again

Before you move on

What does shèng mean? ("To be left over".) Say it once more.

Chapter 452

After the Meal

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about digesting a meal, good reviews, tips, the light of the sky and paper napkins.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 452: I can talk about digesting a meal, good reviews, tips, the light of the sky and paper napkins.*

452.1 xiāohuà — to digest

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a meatless dish, then the Mandarin for to be left over.

You'll want to know: xiāohuà

xiāohuà — "to digest".

> *chī le fàn mǎshàng shuìjiào duì xiāohuà bù hǎo* — Going to bed right after a meal is bad for your digestion.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāohuà is built from *xiāo* 'to melt away' and *huà* 'to change', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjew* and *xwaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to use up' and the second 'to change'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāohuà*
- *Say it: xiāohuà*, once more
- *Say it: chī le fàn mǎshàng shuìjiào duì xiāohuà bù hǎo* — Going to bed right after a meal is bad for your digestion.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a meatless dish, then the Mandarin for to be left over, then say *xiāohuà* again

Before you move on

What does xiāohuà mean? ("To digest".) Say it once more.

452.2 hǎopíng — good review; favourable comment

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be left over, then the Mandarin for to digest food.

You'll want to know: hǎopíng

hǎopíng — "good review; favourable comment".

zhè jiā fànguǎn yǒu hěn duō hǎopíng — This restaurant has lots of good reviews.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎopíng is built from 好 'good' and *píng* 'to judge', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *bjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to weigh up'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎopíng*
- *Say it: hǎopíng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fànguǎn yǒu hěn duō hǎopíng* — This restaurant has lots of good reviews.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be left over, then the Mandarin for to digest food, then say *hǎopíng* again

Before you move on

What does hǎopíng mean? ("Good review; favourable comment".) Say it once more.

452.3 xiǎofèi — tip; a tip for the waiter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to digest food, then the Mandarin for a good review online.

You'll want to know: xiǎofèi

xiǎofèi — "tip; a tip for the waiter".

zài Zhōngguó chīfàn yìbān bù gěi xiǎofèi — In China you don't usually leave a tip when you eat out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiǎofèi is built from 小 'small' and *fèi* 'a cost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to spend'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎofèi*
- *Say it: xiǎofèi*, once more
- *Say it: zài Zhōngguó chīfàn yìbān bù gěi xiǎofèi* — In China you don't usually leave a tip when you eat out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to digest food, then the Mandarin for a good review online, then say *xiǎofèi* again

Before you move on

What does xiǎofèi mean? ("Tip; a tip for the waiter".) Say it once more.

452.4 天色 (tiānsè) — the light of the sky; how dark the sky is getting

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a good review online, then the Mandarin for a tip for the waiter.

You'll want to know: 天色

天色 — *tiānsè* — "the light of the sky; how dark the sky is getting".

> 天色不早了我们坐车回酒店 *tiānsè bù zǎo le wǒmen zuò chē huí jiǔdiàn* — It's getting late, so we're heading back to the hotel.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

天色 (*tiānsè*) is built from 天 'the sky' and 色 'a colour', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *then* and *srik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānsè*
- *Say it: tiānsè*, once more
- *Say it: tiānsè bù zǎo le wǒmen zuò chē huí jiǔdiàn* — It's getting late, so we're heading back to the hotel.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a good review online, then the Mandarin for a tip for the waiter, then say *tiānsè* again

Before you move on

What does 天色 mean? ("The light of the sky; how dark the sky is getting".) Say it once more.

452.5 cānjīnzhǐ — paper napkin

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tip for the waiter, then the Mandarin for how dark the sky is getting.

You'll want to know: cānjīnzhǐ

cānjīnzhǐ — "paper napkin".

fúwùyuán qǐng gěi wǒ jǐ zhāng cānjīnzhǐ — Excuse me, could I have a few napkins, please?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cānjīnzhǐ is built from *cān* 'a meal', *jīn* 'a cloth' and *zhǐ* 'paper', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshan*, *kin* and *tsyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to swallow'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cānjīnzhǐ*
- *Say it:* *cānjīnzhǐ*, once more
- *Say it:* *fúwùyuán qǐng gěi wǒ jǐ zhāng cānjīnzhǐ* — Excuse me, could I have a few napkins, please?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tip for the waiter, then the Mandarin for how dark the sky is getting, then say *cānjīnzhǐ* again

Before you move on

What does cānjīnzhǐ mean? ("Paper napkin".) Say it once more.

452.6 Looking back: from At the Market to After the Meal

Say the Mandarin for a market stall and a marketplace.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a market stall, a marketplace, the built-up part of a city, a market held at dawn, to set up a street stall
- *Say it:* a night market, one's taste in food, a distinctive local flavour, light and mild (of food), greasy (of food)
- *Say it:* seafood, a distinguishing trait, specially for that reason, authentic, a restaurant's signature dish
- *Say it:* to eat no meat, a special character of its own, outstanding, a meatless dish, to be left over
- *Say it:* to digest food, a good review online, a tip for the waiter, how dark the sky is getting, a paper napkin
- *Read it:* 市 味 特 色 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A market stall? (*tānwèi.*) A marketplace? (市场, *shìchǎng.*) The built-up part of a city? (市区, *shìqū.*) A market held at dawn? (早市, *zǎoshì.*) To set up a street stall? (*bǎitān.*) A night market? (*yèshì.*) One's taste in food? (口味, *kǒuwèi.*) A distinctive local flavour? (风味, *fēngwèi.*) Light and mild (of food)? (*qīngdàn.*) Greasy (of food)? (*yóunì.*) Seafood? (*hǎixiān.*) A distinguishing trait? (特点, *tèdiǎn.*) Specially for that reason? (特意, *tèyì.*) Authentic? (*zhèngzōng.*) A restaurant's signature dish? (*zhāopáicài.*) To eat no meat? (*chīsù.*) A special character of its own? (特色, *tèsè.*) Outstanding? (出色, *chūsè.*) A meatless dish? (*sùcài.*) To be left over? (*shèng.*) To digest food? (*xiāohuà.*) A good review online? (*hǎopíng.*) A tip for the waiter? (*xiǎofèi.*) How dark the sky is getting? (天色, *tiānsè.*) A paper napkin? (*cānjīnzhǐ.*)

Chapter 453

Bags and Cases

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a backpack, a suitcase, stuffing things in, carrying a case and a luggage tag.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 453: I can talk about a backpack, a suitcase, stuffing things in, carrying a case and a luggage tag.*

453.1 bēibāo — backpack; rucksack

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how dark the sky is getting, then the Mandarin for a paper napkin.

You'll want to know: bēibāo

bēibāo — "backpack; rucksack".

> *wǒ de bēibāo bú jiàn le* — My backpack has gone missing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bēibāo is built from *bēi* 'to carry on the back' and 包 'a bag', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwojH* and *paew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the back of the body and the second 'to wrap'; the level-toned bēi 'to carry on the back' is irregular beside it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bēibāo*
- *Say it: bēibāo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de bēibāo bú jiàn le* — My backpack has gone missing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how dark the sky is getting, then the Mandarin for a paper napkin, then say *bēibāo* again

Before you move on

What does bēibāo mean? ("Backpack; rucksack".) Say it once more.

453.2 xínglixiāng — luggage case; a travel case

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a paper napkin, then the Mandarin for a backpack.

You'll want to know: xínglixiāng

xínglixiāng — "luggage case; a travel case".

wǒ de xínglixiāng fàng zài fángjiān lǐ — My suitcase is in the room.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xínglixiāng is built from *xíngli* 'luggage' and *xiāng* 'a box', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeng*, *liX* and *sjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses *lǐ* as a fruit tree and gives *xíngli* itself under it, and glosses *xiāng* as a box or a basket.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xínglixiāng*
- *Say it: xínglixiāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de xínglixiāng fàng zài fángjiān lǐ* — My suitcase is in the room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a paper napkin, then the Mandarin for a backpack, then say *xínglixiāng* again

Before you move on

What does xínglixiāng mean? ("Luggage case; a travel case".) Say it once more.

453.3 sāi — to stuff in; to squeeze in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a backpack, then the Mandarin for a travel case.

You'll want to know: sāi

sāi — "to stuff in; to squeeze in".

yīfu dōu sāi zài xiāngzi lǐ le — The clothes are all stuffed into the case.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sāi is inherited from Middle Chinese *sok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'full', 'stopped up' and 'to separate'; today's level-toned sāi is irregular beside it. The dictionary lists a second reading, *sojH*, glossed as a frontier pass.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāi*
- *Say it: sāi*, once more
- *Say it: yīfu dōu sāi zài xiāngzi lǐ le* — The clothes are all stuffed into the case.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a backpack, then the Mandarin for a travel case, then say *sāi* again

Before you move on

What does sāi mean? ("To stuff in; to squeeze in".) Say it once more.

453.4 līn — to carry in the hand (by a handle)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a travel case, then the Mandarin for to stuff into a bag.

You'll want to know: līn

līn — "to carry in the hand (by a handle)".

nǐ néng bāng wǒ līn zhège bāo ma — Could you carry this bag for me?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

līn is inherited from Middle Chinese *leng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as holding something so it hangs from the hand; today's līn is irregular beside it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: līn*
- *Say it: līn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ néng bāng wǒ līn zhège bāo ma* — Could you carry this bag for me?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a travel case, then the Mandarin for to stuff into a bag, then say *līn* again

Before you move on

What does līn mean? ("To carry in the hand (by a handle)".) Say it once more.

453.5 biāoqiān — label; luggage tag

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stuff into a bag, then the Mandarin for to carry in the hand.

You'll want to know: biāoqiān

biāoqiān — "label; luggage tag".

měi ge xínglixiāng dōu yǒu yí ge biāoqiān — Every suitcase has a tag.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biāoqiān is built from *biāo* 'a mark' and *qiān* 'a tally', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjiew* and *tshjem* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to raise' and the second, after an older dictionary, 'to check'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: biāoqiān*
- *Say it: biāoqiān*, once more
- *Say it: měi ge xínglixiāng dōu yǒu yí ge biāoqiān* — Every suitcase has a tag.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stuff into a bag, then the Mandarin for to carry in the hand, then say *biāoqiān* again

Before you move on

What does biāoqiān mean? ("Label; luggage tag".) Say it once more.

Chapter 454

The Information Desk

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find the information desk, make an inquiry, talk about books, give directions and pick up a brochure.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 454: I can find the information desk, make an inquiry, talk about books, give directions and pick up a brochure.*

454.1 fúwùtái — service desk; information desk

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to carry in the hand, then the Mandarin for a luggage tag.

You'll want to know: fúwùtái

fúwùtái — "service desk; information desk".

> *qù fúwùtái zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the information desk?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fúwùtái is built from *fúwù* 'to serve' and *tái* 'a platform', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuwk*, *mjuH* and *doj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to serve', the second 'affairs' and the last as a high square terrace.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fúwùtái*
- *Say it: fúwùtái*, once more
- *Say it: qù fúwùtái zěnme zǒu* — How do I get to the information desk?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to carry in the hand, then the Mandarin for a luggage tag, then say *fúwùtái* again

Before you move on

What does fúwùtái mean? ("Service desk; information desk".) Say it once more.

454.2 zīxún — to make an inquiry; to ask for advice

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a luggage tag, then the Mandarin for an information desk.

You'll want to know: zīxún

zīxún — "to make an inquiry; to ask for advice".

nǐ kěyǐ qù fúwùtái zīxún — You can ask at the information desk.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zīxún is built from *zī* 'to consult' and *xún* 'to ask', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsɨj* and *swin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to take counsel' and the second 'to consult'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zīxún*
- *Say it: zīxún*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ kěyǐ qù fúwùtái zīxún* — You can ask at the information desk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a luggage tag, then the Mandarin for an information desk, then say *zīxún* again

Before you move on

What does zīxún mean? ("To make an inquiry; to ask for advice".) Say it once more.

454.3 图书 (túshū) — books on the shelves (of a library or bookshop)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an information desk, then the Mandarin for to make an inquiry.

You'll want to know: 图书

图书 — *túshū* — "books on the shelves (of a library or bookshop)".

> 这家书店的中文图书很多 *zhè jiā shūdiàn de Zhōngwén túshū hěn duō* — This bookshop has lots of Chinese books.

The new character, in pieces: 图 — eight strokes: the frame of 国, and inside it a short stroke falling to the left, a bar that turns down to the left, a long stroke falling to the right, and two dots. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

图书 (*túshū*) is built from 图 'a picture' and 书 'a book', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *du* and *syo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to plan'; the sense 'a picture, a map' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: túshū*
- *Say it: túshū*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā shūdiàn de Zhōngwén túshū hěn duō* — This bookshop has lots of Chinese books.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an information desk, then the Mandarin for to make an inquiry, then say *túshū* again

Before you move on

What does 图书 mean? ("Books on the shelves (of a library or bookshop)".) Say it once more.

454.4 图 — a frame, and five strokes inside it

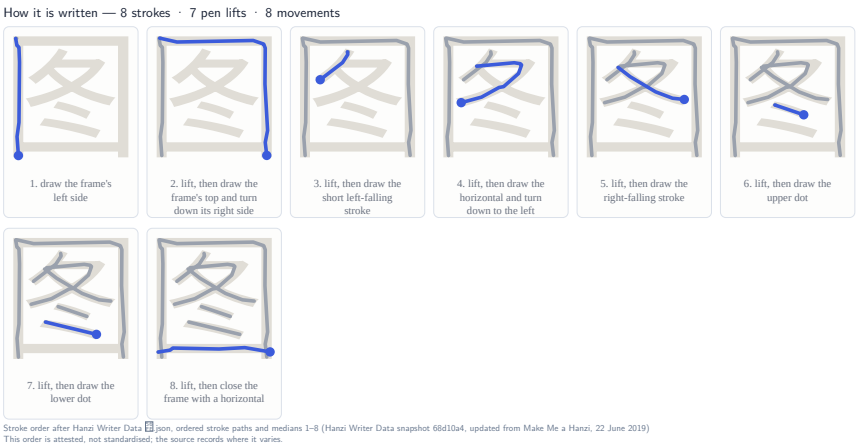
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *túshū* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  国 回

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *guó*, *huí*

Script — a frame, and five strokes inside it



How 图 *is written, stroke by stroke*

图

A frame and what is inside it, as in 国: the frame opens first, takes its inside, and closes last.

The frame, three strokes. A vertical down the left. A bar that turns down the right side. The bar across the foot comes last, after the inside.

The inside, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A bar that turns down to the left. A long stroke falling to the right, across it. Then two dots, one under the other.

$2 + 5 + 1 =$ eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 图, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes in 图? (**Eight**.) Which stroke comes last? (**The bar that closes the frame at the foot**.) How many dots inside? (**Two**.)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 图, pinned stroke paths and medians.

454.5 zhǐlù — to give directions; to show someone the way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make an inquiry, then the Mandarin for books on the shelves.

You'll want to know: zhǐlù

zhǐlù — "to give directions; to show someone the way".

tā gěi wǒ zhǐlù gàosu wǒ wǎng qián zǒu — He gave me directions and told me to go straight on.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǐlù is built from *zhǐ* 'to point' and 路 'a road', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyijX* and *luH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a finger and 'to show'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǐlù*
- *Say it: zhǐlù*, once more
- *Say it: tā gěi wǒ zhǐlù gàosu wǒ wǎng qián zǒu* — He gave me directions and told me to go straight on.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make an inquiry, then the Mandarin for books on the shelves, then say *zhǐlù* again

Before you move on

What does zhǐlù mean? ("To give directions; to show someone the way".) Say it once more.

454.6 xuānchuáncè — brochure; leaflet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for books on the shelves, then the Mandarin for to show someone the way.

You'll want to know: xuānchuáncè

xuānchuáncè — "brochure; leaflet".

fúwùtái yǒu hěn duō miǎnfèi de xuānchuáncè — The information desk has lots of free brochures.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuānchuáncè is built from *xuānchuán* 'to spread the word' and *cè* 'a booklet', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjwen*, *drjwen* and *tsrheak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to spread', the second 'to turn' and the last as a set of bamboo slips.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuānchuáncè*
- *Say it: xuānchuáncè*, once more
- *Say it: fúwùtái yǒu hěn duō miǎnfèi de xuānchuáncè* — The information desk has lots of free brochures.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for books on the shelves, then the Mandarin for to show someone the way, then say *xuānchuáncè* again

Before you move on

What does xuānchuáncè mean? (“Brochure; leaflet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 455

Forms

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give my full name and nationality, say a document has expired or is valid, and apply for a visa.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 455: I can give my full name and nationality, say a document has expired or is valid, and apply for a visa.*

455.1 xìngmíng — full name

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to show someone the way, then the Mandarin for a travel brochure.

You'll want to know: xìngmíng

xìngmíng — "full name".

> *qǐng zài zhèr xiě nǐ de xìngmíng* — Please put your full name here.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìngmíng is built from *xìng* 'a surname' and 名 'a name', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjengH* and *mjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìngmíng*
- *Say it: xìngmíng*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng zài zhèr xiě nǐ de xìngmíng* — Please put your full name here.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to show someone the way, then the Mandarin for a travel brochure, then say *xìngmíng* again

Before you move on

What does xìngmíng mean? ("Full name".) Say it once more.

455.2 guójí — citizenship; the country one belongs to

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a travel brochure, then the Mandarin for one's full name.

You'll want to know: guójí

guójí — "citizenship; the country one belongs to".

tā zhù zài Běijīng dànshì tā de guójí shì Yīngguó — He lives in Beijing, but he's a UK citizen.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guójí is built from 国 'a country' and *jí* 'a register', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *dzjek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a written roll.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: guójí*
- *Say it: guójí*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhù zài Běijīng dànshì tā de guójí shì Yīngguó* — He lives in Beijing, but he's a UK citizen.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a travel brochure, then the Mandarin for one's full name, then say *guójí* again

Before you move on

What does guójí mean? ("Citizenship; the country one belongs to".) Say it once more.

455.3 过期 (guòqī) — to be out of date; to have expired

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's full name, then the Mandarin for one's citizenship.

You'll want to know: 过期

过期 — *guòqī* — "to be out of date; to have expired".

wǒ de qiānzhèng guòqī le — My visa has expired.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

过期 (*guòqī*) is built from 过 'to pass' and 期 'a set time', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaH* and *gi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a time agreed on; today's level-toned qī is irregular beside it.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: guòqī*
- *Say it: guòqī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de qiānzhèng guòqī le* — My visa has expired.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's full name, then the Mandarin for one's citizenship, then say *guòqī* again

Before you move on

What does 过期 mean? ("To be out of date; to have expired".) Say it once more.

455.4 yǒuxiào — valid; effective

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's citizenship, then the Mandarin for to be out of date.

You'll want to know: yǒuxiào

yǒuxiào — "valid; effective".

zhè zhāng ménpiào jīntiān yǒuxiào — This ticket is valid today.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǒuxiào is built from 有 'to have' and *xiào* 'an effect', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *haewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to imitate' and 'an effect'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒuxiào*
- *Say it: yǒuxiào*, once more
- *Say it: zhè zhāng ménpiào jīntiān yǒuxiào* — This ticket is valid today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's citizenship, then the Mandarin for to be out of date, then say *yǒuxiào* again

Before you move on

What does yǒuxiào mean? ("Valid; effective".) Say it once more.

455.5 shēnqǐng — to apply for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be out of date, then the Mandarin for still valid.

You'll want to know: shēnqǐng

shēnqǐng — "to apply for".

wǒ zuò huǒchē qù Běijīng shēnqǐng qiānzhèng — I'm taking the train to Beijing to apply for a visa.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēnqǐng is built from *shēn* 'to state' and 请 'to ask', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syin* and *tshjengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stretch' and 'to repeat' and the second 'to beg'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnqǐng*
- *Say it: shēnqǐng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuò huǒchē qù Běijīng shēnqǐng qiānzhèng* — I'm taking the train to Beijing to apply for a visa.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be out of date, then the Mandarin for still valid, then say *shēnqǐng* again

Before you move on

What does shēnqǐng mean? ("To apply for".) Say it once more.

Chapter 456

Lost and Found

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say we got separated, ask for help, ask a passer-by, and talk about the owner of a lost wallet claiming it.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 456: I can say we got separated, ask for help, ask a passer-by, and talk about the owner of a lost wallet claiming it.*

456.1 zǒusàn — to get separated (in a crowd)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for still valid, then the Mandarin for to apply for.

You'll want to know: zǒusàn

zǒusàn — "to get separated (in a crowd)".

> *wǒ hé péngyou zài huǒchēzhàn zǒusàn le* — My friend and I lost each other at the station.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zǒusàn is built from 走 'to walk' and *sàn* 'to scatter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsuwX* and *sanH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to run' and the second 'to break

apart'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǒusàn*
- *Say it: zǒusàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hé péngyou zài huǒchēzhàn zǒusàn le* — My friend and I lost each other at the station.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for still valid, then the Mandarin for to apply for, then say *zǒusàn* again

Before you move on

What does zǒusàn mean? ("To get separated (in a crowd)".) Say it once more.

456.2 qiúzhù — to ask for help; to turn to someone for help

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to apply for, then the Mandarin for to get separated.

You'll want to know: qiúzhù

qiúzhù — "to ask for help; to turn to someone for help".

wǒ zhǎo bu dào péngyou qù fúwùtái qiúzhù — I can't find my friend, so I'm going to the information desk for help.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiúzhù is built from *qiú* 'to seek' and *zhù* 'to help', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *dzrjoH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to search for' and the second 'to assist'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúzhù*
- *Say it: qiúzhù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhǎo bu dào péngyou qù fúwùtái qiúzhù* — I can't find my friend, so I'm going to the information desk for help.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to apply for, then the Mandarin for to get separated, then say *qiúzhù* again

Before you move on

What does qiúzhù mean? ("To ask for help; to turn to someone for help".) Say it once more.

456.3 路人 (lùrén) — passer-by; stranger in the street

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get separated, then the Mandarin for to turn to someone for help.

You'll want to know: 路人

路人 — *lùrén* — "passer-by; stranger in the street".

我的地图不见了我问了一个路人 *wǒ de dìtú bú jiàn le wǒ wèn le yí ge lùrén* — My map had gone, so I asked a passer-by.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

路人 (*lùrén*) is built from 路 'a road' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luH* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: lùrén*
- *Say it: lùrén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de dìtú bú jiàn le wǒ wèn le yí ge lùrén* — My map had gone, so I asked a passer-by.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get separated, then the Mandarin for to turn to someone for help, then say *lùrén* again

Before you move on

What does 路人 mean? ("Passer-by; stranger in the street".) Say it once more.

456.4 shīzhǔ — the owner of a lost item

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn to someone for help, then the Mandarin for a passer-by.

You'll want to know: shīzhǔ

shīzhǔ — "the owner of a lost item".

wǒmen zhǎodào le yí ge qiánbāo zhèngzài zhǎo shīzhǔ — We found a wallet and we're looking for its owner.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīzhǔ is built from *shī* 'to lose' and *zhǔ* 'an owner', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *tsyuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to err' and the second 'to be in charge'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīzhǔ*
- *Say it: shīzhǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhǎodào le yí ge qiánbāo zhèngzài zhǎo shīzhǔ* — We found a wallet and we're looking for its owner.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn to someone for help, then the Mandarin for a passer-by, then say *shīzhǔ* again

Before you move on

What does shīzhǔ mean? ("The owner of a lost item".) Say it once more.

456.5 rènlǐng — to claim lost property

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a passer-by, then the Mandarin for the owner of a lost item.

You'll want to know: rènlǐng

rènlǐng — "to claim lost property".

shīzhǔ kěyǐ qù fúwùtái rènlǐng qiánbāo — The owner can claim the wallet at the information desk.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rènlǐng is built from *rèn* 'to recognise' and *lǐng* 'to receive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyinH* and *ljengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to know' and the second 'to take charge of'; the sense 'to receive' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: rènlǐng*
- *Say it: rènlǐng*, once more
- *Say it: shīzhǔ kěyǐ qù fúwùtái rènlǐng qiánbāo* — The owner can claim the wallet at the information desk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a passer-by, then the Mandarin for the owner of a lost item, then say *rènlǐng* again

Before you move on

What does rènlǐng mean? ("To claim lost property".) Say it once more.

Chapter 457

Thanks for the Help

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask a stranger's help politely, ask a favour, say thanks a lot, say I am grateful and ask for a good way to do something.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 457: I can ask a stranger's help politely, ask a favour, say thanks a lot, say I am grateful and ask for a good way to do something.*

457.1 láojià — may I trouble you (asking a favour)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the owner of a lost item, then the Mandarin for to claim lost property.

You'll want to know: láojià

láojià — "may I trouble you (asking a favour)".

> *láojià qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu* — Excuse me, how do I get to the railway station?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

láojià is built from *láo* 'to tire' and *jià* 'a carriage', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *law* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'weary' and the second 'to ride'. The pair is usually explained as an old polite way of asking someone to trouble their carriage.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: láojià*
- *Say it: láojià*, once more
- *Say it: láojià qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu* — Excuse me, how do I get to the railway station?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the owner of a lost item, then the Mandarin for to claim lost property, then say *láojià* again

Before you move on

What does láojià mean? ("May I trouble you (asking a favour)".) Say it once more.

457.2 bàituō — to ask a favour of someone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to claim lost property, then the Mandarin for may I trouble you.

You'll want to know: bàituō

bàituō — "to ask a favour of someone".

bàituō nǐ bāng wǒ ná xíngli — Could you carry my luggage for me, please?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bàituō is built from *bài* 'to bow' and *tuō* 'to entrust', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *peajH* and *thak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to entrust'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàituō*
- *Say it: bàituō*, once more
- *Say it: bàituō nǐ bāng wǒ ná xíngli* — Could you carry my luggage for me, please?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to claim lost property, then the Mandarin for may I trouble you, then say *bàituō* again

Before you move on

What does bàituō mean? ("To ask a favour of someone".) Say it once more.

457.3 多谢 (duōxiè) — many thanks; thanks a lot

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for may I trouble you, then the Mandarin for to ask a favour of someone.

You'll want to know: 多谢

多谢 — *duōxiè* — "many thanks; thanks a lot".

多谢你我找到地图了 *duōxiè nǐ wǒ zhǎodào dìtú le* — Thanks so much: I've found my map.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

多谢 (*duōxiè*) is built from 多 'many' and 谢 'to thank', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ta* and *zjaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to decline'; the sense 'to thank' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: duōxiè*
- *Say it: duōxiè*, once more
- *Say it: duōxiè nǐ wǒ zhǎodào dìtú le* — Thanks so much: I've found my map.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for may I trouble you, then the Mandarin for to ask a favour of someone, then say *duōxiè* again

Before you move on

What does 多谢 mean? ("Many thanks; thanks a lot".) Say it once more.

457.4 gǎnjī — to feel deeply grateful

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ask a favour of someone, then the Mandarin for thanks a lot.

You'll want to know: gǎnjī

gǎnjī — "to feel deeply grateful".

nǐ bāng le wǒ hěn duō wǒ hěn gǎnjī — You've helped me so much; I'm very grateful.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎnjī is built from *gǎn* 'to be moved' and *jī* 'to surge', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *kek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move' and the second as a rushing wave.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnjī*
- *Say it: gǎnjī*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bāng le wǒ hěn duō wǒ hěn gǎnjī* — You've helped me so much; I'm very grateful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ask a favour of someone, then the Mandarin for thanks a lot, then say *gǎnjī* again

Before you move on

What does gǎnjī mean? ("To feel deeply grateful".) Say it once more.

457.5 方法 (fāngfǎ) — a way to solve a problem; means

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for thanks a lot, then the Mandarin for to feel deeply grateful.

You'll want to know: 方法

方法 — *fāngfǎ* — "a way to solve a problem; means".

找不到路的时候你有什么好方法 *zhǎo bu dào lù de shíhou nǐ yǒu shénme hǎo fāngfǎ* — When you can't find the way, what do you do?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

方法 (*fāngfǎ*) is built from 方 'a technique' and 法 'a rule', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjang* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, among other senses, as an art or technique and the second 'a rule'.

What you've built

One more word for getting around.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāngfǎ*
- *Say it: fāngfǎ*, once more
- *Say it: zhǎo bu dào lù de shíhou nǐ yǒu shénme hǎo fāngfǎ* — When you can't find the way, what do you do?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for thanks a lot, then the Mandarin for to feel deeply grateful, then say *fāngfǎ* again

Before you move on

What does 方法 mean? ("A way to solve a problem; means".) Say it once more.

457.6 Looking back: from Bags and Cases to Thanks for the Help

Say the Mandarin for a backpack and a travel case.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a backpack, a travel case, to stuff into a bag, to carry in the hand, a luggage tag
- *Say it:* an information desk, to make an inquiry, books on the shelves, to show someone the way, a travel brochure

- *Say it:* one's full name, one's citizenship, to be out of date, still valid, to apply for
- *Say it:* to get separated, to turn to someone for help, a passer-by, the owner of a lost item, to claim lost property
- *Say it:* may I trouble you, to ask a favour of someone, thanks a lot, to feel deeply grateful, a way to solve a problem
- *Read it:* 图 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A backpack? (*bēibāo.*) A travel case? (*xínglixiāng.*) To stuff into a bag? (*sāi.*) To carry in the hand? (*līn.*) A luggage tag? (*biāoqiān.*) An information desk? (*fúwùtái.*) To make an inquiry? (*zīxún.*) Books on the shelves? (图书, *túshū.*) To show someone the way? (*zhǐlù.*) A travel brochure? (*xuānchuáncè.*) One's full name? (*xìngmíng.*) One's citizenship? (*guójí.*) To be out of date? (过期, *guòqī.*) Still valid? (*yǒuxiào.*) To apply for? (*shēnqǐng.*) To get separated? (*zǒusàn.*) To turn to someone for help? (*qiúzhù.*) A passer-by? (路人, *lùrén.*) The owner of a lost item? (*shīzhǔ.*) To claim lost property? (*rènlǐng.*) May I trouble you? (*láojià.*) To ask a favour of someone? (*bàituō.*) Thanks a lot? (多谢, *duōxiè.*) To feel deeply grateful? (*gǎnjī.*) A way to solve a problem? (方法, *fāngfǎ.*)

457.7 Thanks for the Help — once more

Say the Mandarin for may I trouble you and to ask a favour of someone.

Your turn

- *Say it:* may I trouble you, to ask a favour of someone, thanks a lot, to feel deeply grateful, a way to solve a problem

Before you move on

May I trouble you? (*láojià.*) To ask a favour of someone? (*bàituō.*) Thanks a lot? (多谢, *duōxiè.*) To feel deeply grateful? (*gǎnjī.*) A way to solve a problem? (方法, *fāngfǎ.*)

Chapter 458

How I Feel

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my mood, feeling for someone, being excited, relaxed or fed up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 458: I can talk about my mood, feeling for someone, being excited, relaxed or fed up.*

458.1 qíngxù — emotions; spirits

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to feel deeply grateful, then the Mandarin for a way to solve a problem.

You'll want to know: qíngxù

qíngxù — "emotions; spirits".

> *zuìjìn wǒ de qíngxù bú tài hǎo* — My mood hasn't been great lately.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qíngxù is built from *qíng* 'feeling' and *xù* 'the end of a thread', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjeng* and *zjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the first, after an older book, as what a person desires, and the second as the loose end of silk; the sense 'mood' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qíngxù*
- *Say it: qíngxù*, once more
- *Say it: zuìjìn wǒ de qíngxù bú tài hǎo* — My mood hasn't been great lately.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to feel deeply grateful, then the Mandarin for a way to solve a problem, then say *qíngxù* again

Before you move on

What does qíngxù mean? ("Emotions; spirits".) Say it once more.

458.2 心疼 (xīnténg) — to feel for someone; to love dearly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a way to solve a problem, then the Mandarin for one's spirits.

You'll want to know: 心疼

心疼 — *xīnténg* — "to feel for someone; to love dearly".

> 孩子病了妈妈很心疼 *háizi bìng le māma hěn xīnténg* — The child is ill, and her mother's heart aches for her.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心疼 (*xīnténg*) is built from 心 'heart' and 疼 'pain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *downg* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'pain'. The regular sound change would give *tóng* for the second; why the vowel differs is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnténg*
- *Say it: xīnténg*, once more
- *Say it: háizi bìng le māma hěn xīnténg* — The child is ill, and her mother's heart aches for her.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a way to solve a problem, then the Mandarin for one's spirits, then say *xīnténg* again

Before you move on

What does 心疼 mean? ("To feel for someone; to love dearly".) Say it once more.

458.3 xīngfèn — thrilled; keyed up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's spirits, then the Mandarin for to feel for someone.

You'll want to know: xīngfèn

xīngfèn — "thrilled; keyed up".

míngtiān qù Zhōngguó wǒ gǎnjué hěn xīngfèn — I'm going to China tomorrow, and I feel really excited.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīngfèn is built from *xīng* 'to rise' and *fèn* 'to spread the wings', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xing* and *pjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and 'to flourish' and the second as a bird spreading its feathers. The sense 'excited' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīngfèn*
- *Say it: xīngfèn*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān qù Zhōngguó wǒ gǎnjué hěn xīngfèn* — I'm going to China tomorrow, and I feel really excited.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's spirits, then the Mandarin for to feel for someone, then say *xīngfèn* again

Before you move on

What does xīngfèn mean? ("Thrilled; keyed up".) Say it once more.

458.4 qīngsōng — relaxed; light and easy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to feel for someone, then the Mandarin for thrilled.

You'll want to know: qīngsōng

qīngsōng — "relaxed; light and easy".

kǎoshì yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn qīngsōng — After the exam I feel really relaxed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīngsōng is built from *qīng* 'light' and *sōng* 'loose', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khjieng* and *sowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as light against heavy, and lists the second under the spelling for loose, tousled hair; the sense 'relaxed' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīngsōng*
- *Say it: qīngsōng*, once more
- *Say it: kǎoshì yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn qīngsōng* — After the exam I feel really relaxed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to feel for someone, then the Mandarin for thrilled, then say *qīngsōng* again

Before you move on

What does qīngsōng mean? ("Relaxed; light and easy".) Say it once more.

458.5 fán — annoyed; fed up

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for thrilled, then the Mandarin for relaxed and at ease.

You'll want to know: fán

fán — "annoyed; fed up".

zhǎo bu dào wǒ de xínglixiāng wǒ hěn fán — I can't find my suitcase, and I'm really fed up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fán is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'weary', and explained after an older book as a hot, aching head. The same syllable is the first half of *máfan* 'trouble'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fán*
- *Say it: fán*, once more
- *Say it: zhǎo bu dào wǒ de xínglixiāng wǒ hěn fán* — I can't find my suitcase, and I'm really fed up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for thrilled, then the Mandarin for relaxed and at ease, then say *fán* again

Before you move on

What does fán mean? ("Annoyed; fed up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 459

On My Mind

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I feel lonely, that I have a lot to do, talk about feelings between people and what is on my mind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 459: I can say I feel lonely, that I have a lot to do, talk about feelings between people and what is on my mind.*

459.1 gūdān — lonely; on one's own

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for relaxed and at ease, then the Mandarin for fed up.

You'll want to know: gūdān

gūdān — "lonely; on one's own".

> *wǒ yí ge rén zhù le liǎng nián yǒudiǎnr gūdān* — I've lived on my own for two years, and I'm a bit lonely.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gūdān is built from *gū* 'an orphan' and *dān* 'single', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ku* and *tan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a fatherless child' and the second as single against double.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gūdān*
- *Say it: gūdān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yí ge rén zhù le liǎng nián yǒudiǎnr gūdān* — I've lived on my own for two years, and I'm a bit lonely.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for relaxed and at ease, then the Mandarin for fed up, then say *gūdān* again

Before you move on

What does gūdān mean? ("Lonely; on one's own".) Say it once more.

459.2 事情 (shìqing) — matter; affair

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fed up, then the Mandarin for lonely.

You'll want to know: 事情

事情 — *shìqing* — "matter; affair".

今天我有很多事情要做 *jīntiān wǒ yǒu hěn duō shìqing yào zuò* — I've got a lot of things to do today.

The new character, in pieces: 情 — eleven strokes in three pieces: on the left the heart piece, a dot, a second dot and a long vertical; at the top right a bar, a second bar, a vertical through them and a long bar; and under them 月 *yuè*, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

事情 (*shìqing*) is built from 事 'an affair' and 情 'feeling', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzriH* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to employ' and 'to set up', and explains the second, after an older book, as what a person desires; in this word the second is said light, and why it joins the first is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìqing*
- *Say it: shìqing*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān wǒ yǒu hěn duō shìqing yào zuò* — I've got a lot of things to do today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fed up, then the Mandarin for lonely, then say *shìqing* again

Before you move on

What does 事情 mean? ("Matter; affair".) Say it once more.

459.3 情 — the heart piece, then a top over 月

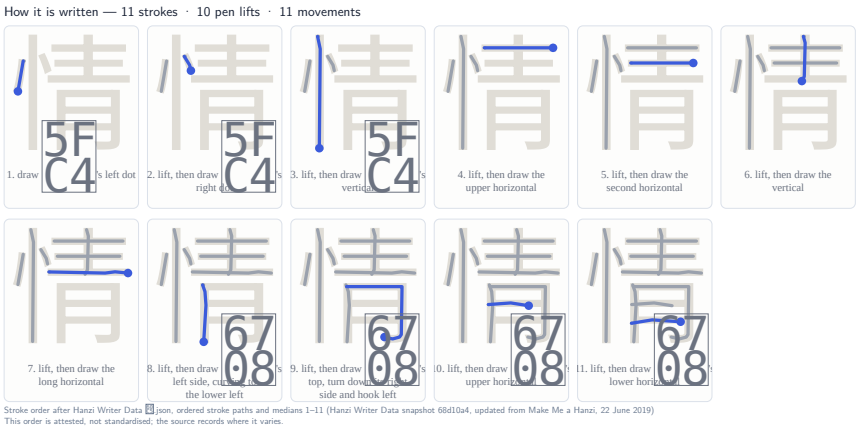
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shìqing* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  月 事

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yuè*, *shì*

Script — the heart piece, then a top over 月



How 情 *is written, stroke by stroke*

情

Three pieces: the left first, then the top right, then the bottom right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes: the heart piece. A short dot on the left, a short dot on the right falling to the right, then a long vertical down between them from top to foot.

The top right, four strokes. A bar from left to right, a second bar under it, a vertical down through both, then a long bar under them, wider than the two above.

The bottom right, 月, four strokes. The stroke down the left that curves to the left at the foot, the stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks, then the two short bars inside.

3 + 4 + 4 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 情, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 情 have? (**Three: three strokes, four and four.**) Which piece comes last? (**月, at the bottom right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 情, pinned stroke paths and medians.

459.4 感情 (gǎnqíng) — affection between people; feelings for each other

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lonely, then the Mandarin for a matter to deal with.

You'll want to know: 感情

感情 — *gǎnqíng* — "affection between people; feelings for each other".

wǒmen rènshi le shí nián gǎnqíng hěn hǎo — We've known each other for ten years, and we're very close.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

感情 (*gǎnqíng*) is built from 感 'to move' and 情 'feeling', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnqíng*
- *Say it: gǎnqíng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen rènshi le shí nián gǎnqíng hěn hǎo* — We've known each other for ten years, and we're very close.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lonely, then the Mandarin for a matter to deal with, then say *gǎnqíng* again

Before you move on

What does 感情 mean? ("Affection between people; feelings for each other".) Say it once more.

459.5 心里话 (xīnlihuà) — what is really on one's mind; words from the heart

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a matter to deal with, then the Mandarin for affection between people.

You'll want to know: 心里话

心里话 — *xīnlihuà* — "what is really on one's mind; words from the heart".

zhè shì wǒ de xīnlihuà bàituō nǐ bié gàosu biérén — This is what I really think, so please don't tell anyone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心里话 (*xīnlihuà*) is built from 心 'heart', 里 'inside' and 话 'words', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim*, *liX* and *hwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'inside' and the third 'speech'. The middle syllable is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnlihuà*
- *Say it: xīnlihuà*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de xīnlihuà bàituō nǐ bié gàosu biérén* — This is what I really think, so please don't tell anyone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a matter to deal with, then the Mandarin for affection between people, then say *xīnlihuà* again

Before you move on

What does 心里话 mean? ("What is really on one's mind; words from the heart".) Say it once more.

459.6 wěiqu — wronged; hurt by unfair blame

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for affection between people, then the Mandarin for what is really on one's mind.

You'll want to know: wěiqu

wěiqu — "wronged; hurt by unfair blame".

biérén bù xiāngxìn wǒ wǒ gǎnjué hěn wěiqu — Nobody believes me, and I feel really hard done by.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wěiqu is built from *wěi* and *qū*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jweX* and *khjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses both as bent; the sense of a person feeling wronged is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wěiqu*
- *Say it: wěiqu*, once more
- *Say it: biérén bù xiāngxìn wǒ wǒ gǎnjué hěn wěiqu* — Nobody believes me, and I feel really hard done by.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for affection between people, then the Mandarin for what is really on one's mind, then say *wěiqu* again

Before you move on

What does wěiqu mean? (“Wronged; hurt by unfair blame”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 460

Feeling Low

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I feel down, ask why someone sighs, say I am embarrassed and that I feel for someone or envy them.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 460: I can say I feel down, ask why someone sighs, say I am embarrassed and that I feel for someone or envy them.*

460.1 yùmèn — down; gloomy

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what is really on one's mind, then the Mandarin for hurt by unfair blame.

You'll want to know: yùmèn

yùmèn — "down; gloomy".

> *wǒ bìng le yí ge xīngqī hěn yùmèn* — I've been ill for a week, and I'm feeling really down.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùmèn is built from *yù* 'dense' and *mèn* 'vexed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jut* and *mwonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as thick and blocked and the

second 'vexed'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùmèn*
- *Say it: yùmèn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bìng le yí ge xīngqī hěn yùmèn* — I've been ill for a week, and I'm feeling really down.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what is really on one's mind, then the Mandarin for hurt by unfair blame, then say *yùmèn* again

Before you move on

What does yùmèn mean? ("Down; gloomy".) Say it once more.

460.2 tànqì — to sigh

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hurt by unfair blame, then the Mandarin for down in the dumps.

You'll want to know: tànqì

tànqì — "to sigh".

nǐ wèishénme tànqì — Why are you sighing?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tànqì is built from *tàn* 'to sigh' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thanH* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a long breath and the second 'breath'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tànqì*
- *Say it: tànqì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ wèishénme tànqì* — Why are you sighing?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hurt by unfair blame, then the Mandarin for down in the dumps, then say *tànqì* again

Before you move on

What does tànqì mean? ("To sigh".) Say it once more.

460.3 难为情 (nánwéiqíng) — embarrassed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for down in the dumps, then the Mandarin for to sigh.

You'll want to know: 难为情

难为情 — *nánwéiqíng* — "embarrassed".

大家都笑我我很难为情 *dàjiā dōu xiào wǒ wǒ hěn nánwéiqíng* — Everyone laughed at me, and I was so embarrassed.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

难为情 (*nánwéiqíng*) is built from 难 'hard', 为 'to make' and 情 'feeling', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan*, *hjwe* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'hard to do'; the sense 'embarrassed' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánwéiqíng*
- *Say it: nánwéiqíng*, once more
- *Say it: dàjiā dōu xiào wǒ wǒ hěn nánwéiqíng* — Everyone laughed at me, and I was so embarrassed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for down in the dumps, then the Mandarin for to sigh, then say *nánwéiqíng* again

Before you move on

What does 难为情 mean? ("Embarrassed".) Say it once more.

460.4 同情 (tóngqíng) — to sympathize with

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sigh, then the Mandarin for embarrassed.

You'll want to know: 同情

同情 — *tóngqíng* — "to sympathize with".

nàge háizi gēn māma zǒusàn le wǒ hěn tóngqíng tā — That boy got separated from his mother, and I really feel for him.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

同情 (*tóngqíng*) is built from 同 'the same' and 情 'feeling', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwng* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'equal' and 'together'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóngqíng*
- *Say it: tóngqíng*, once more

- *Say it: nàge háizi gēn māma zǒusàn le wǒ hěn tóngqíng tā* — That boy got separated from his mother, and I really feel for him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sigh, then the Mandarin for embarrassed, then say *tóngqíng* again

Before you move on

What does 同情 mean? ("To sympathize with".) Say it once more.

460.5 xiànmù — to envy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for embarrassed, then the Mandarin for to sympathize with.

You'll want to know: xiànmù

xiànmù — "to envy".

nǐ qù guo hěn duō guójiā wǒ hěn xiànmù nǐ — You've been to so many countries; I really envy you.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiànmù is built from *xiàn* 'to covet' and *mù* 'to long for', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zjenH* and *muH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under three readings and glosses this one 'to covet'; it glosses the second as thinking of someone with longing.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiànmù*
- *Say it: xiànmù*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ qù guo hěn duō guójiā wǒ hěn xiànmù nǐ* — You've been to so many countries; I really envy you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for embarrassed, then the Mandarin for to sympathize with, then say *xiànmù* again

Before you move on

What does xiànmù mean? ("To envy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 461

Love and Kindness

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say whom I admire, talk about kindness, love stories and the things I love, and what I look forward to.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 461: I can say whom I admire, talk about kindness, love stories and the things I love, and what I look forward to.*

461.1 pèifú — to think highly of; to hold in high regard

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sympathize with, then the Mandarin for to envy.

You'll want to know: pèifú

pèifú — "to think highly of; to hold in high regard".

> *wǒ zuì pèifú wǒ de lǎoshī* — The person I admire most is my teacher.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pèifú is built from *pèi* 'to wear at the belt' and *fú* 'to serve', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bwojH* and *bjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as jade worn at the belt and the second 'to serve' and 'clothes'. The sense 'to admire' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: pèifú*
- *Say it: pèifú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì pèifú wǒ de lǎoshī* — The person I admire most is my teacher.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sympathize with, then the Mandarin for to envy, then say *pèifú* again

Before you move on

What does pèifú mean? ("To think highly of; to hold in high regard".) Say it once more.

461.2 爱心 (àixīn) — compassion; love and care for others

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to envy, then the Mandarin for to hold in high regard.

You'll want to know: 爱心

爱心 — *àixīn* — "compassion; love and care for others".

nàge lùrén hěn yǒu àixīn wǒ hěn gǎnjī tā — That passer-by was so kind, and I'm very grateful to him.

The new character, in pieces: 爱 — ten strokes in three pieces: at the top a short stroke falling to the left, two dots and a stroke falling to the left, like a hand reaching down; a cover of two strokes, a short stroke down and a bar that turns down with a hook; and under it a bar, a long stroke falling to the left, and 又 *yòu*. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

爱心 (*àixīn*) is built from *ài* 'to love' and 心 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'ojH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to cherish'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: àixīn*
- *Say it: àixīn*, once more
- *Say it: nàge lùrén hěn yǒu àixīn wǒ hěn gǎnjī tā* — That passer-by was so kind, and I'm very grateful to him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to envy, then the Mandarin for to hold in high regard, then say *àixīn* again

Before you move on

What does 爱心 mean? ("Compassion; love and care for others".) Say it once more.

461.3 爱 — a hand on top, a cover, and 又 under them

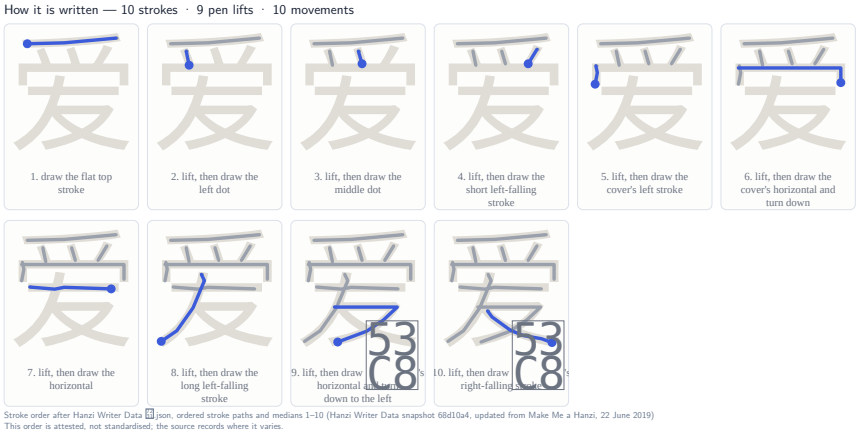
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *àixīn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  又 心

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yòu*, *xīn*

Script — a hand on top, a cover, and 又 under them



How 爱 is written, stroke by stroke

爱

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top, four strokes. A short stroke from the right falling to the left, a dot, a second dot, then a short stroke falling to the left on the right: a hand reaching down.

The cover, two strokes. A short stroke down on the left, then a bar that runs right, turns down and hooks.

The bottom, four strokes. A bar across, a long stroke falling to the left from above the bar, then 又: a bar that turns into a stroke falling to the left, and a long stroke falling to the right.

4 + 2 + 4 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 爱, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 爱 have? (**Three: four strokes, two and four**.) Which written character ends it? (又.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 爱, pinned stroke paths and medians.

461.4 爱情 (àiqíng) — romantic love; love between a couple

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hold in high regard, then the Mandarin for love and care for others.

You'll want to know: 爱情

爱情 — *àiqíng* — "romantic love; love between a couple".

zhè shì wǒ kàn guo de zuì hǎo de àiqíng diànyǐng — This is the best love film I've ever seen.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

爱情 (*àiqíng*) is built from 爱 'to love' and 情 'feeling', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'ojH* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to cherish'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: àiqíng*
- *Say it: àiqíng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ kàn guo de zuì hǎo de àiqíng diànyǐng* — This is the best love film I've ever seen.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hold in high regard, then the Mandarin for love and care for others, then say *àiqíng* again

Before you move on

What does 爱情 mean? ("Romantic love; love between a couple".) Say it once more.

461.5 心爱 (xīn'ài) — beloved; treasured

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for love and care for others, then the Mandarin for love between a couple.

You'll want to know: 心爱

心爱 — *xīn'ài* — "beloved; treasured".

这是我最心爱的书 *zhè shì wǒ zuì xīn'ài de shū* — This is my most treasured book.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心爱 (*xīn'ài*) is built from 心 'heart' and 爱 'to love', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *'ojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to cherish'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīn'ài*
- *Say it: xīn'ài*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ zuì xīn'ài de shū* — This is my most treasured book.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for love and care for others, then the Mandarin for love between a couple, then say *xīn'ài* again

Before you move on

What does 心爱 mean? ("Beloved; treasured".) Say it once more.

461.6 pànwàng — to look forward to; to long for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for love between a couple, then the Mandarin for treasured.

You'll want to know: pànwàng

pànwàng — "to look forward to; to long for".

háizi dōu pànwàng guònián — All the children are looking forward to the new year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pànwàng is built from *pàn* and *wàng* 'to look toward', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pheanH* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as beautiful eyes and the second 'to look toward', after an older book a person far away hoping to come home; the sense 'to look forward to' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: pànwàng*
- *Say it: pànwàng*, once more
- *Say it: háizi dōu pànwàng guònián* — All the children are looking forward to the new year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for love between a couple, then the Mandarin for treasured, then say *pànwàng* again

Before you move on

What does pànwàng mean? ("To look forward to; to long for".) Say it once more.

Chapter 462

Surprises

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a lovely surprise, something unexpected, hating someone, giving up hope and falling out of love.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 462: I can talk about a lovely surprise, something unexpected, hating someone, giving up hope and falling out of love.*

462.1 jīngxǐ — pleasant surprise

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for treasured, then the Mandarin for to look forward to.

You'll want to know: jīngxǐ

jīngxǐ — "pleasant surprise".

> *zhè shì wǒ jīnnián zuì dà de jīngxǐ* — This is the biggest surprise I've had all year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīngxǐ is built from *jīng* 'to startle' and 喜 'joy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaeng* and *xiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'fear' and, after an older book, a

startled horse, and the second 'joy'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīngxǐ*
- *Say it: jīngxǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ jīnnián zuì dà de jīngxǐ* — This is the biggest surprise I've had all year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for treasured, then the Mandarin for to look forward to, then say *jīngxǐ* again

Before you move on

What does jīngxǐ mean? ("Pleasant surprise".) Say it once more.

462.2 意想不到 (yìxiǎngbúdào) — unexpected; beyond what anyone imagined

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to look forward to, then the Mandarin for a pleasant surprise.

You'll want to know: 意想不到

意想不到 — *yìxiǎngbúdào* — "unexpected; beyond what anyone imagined".

> 这真是一个意想不到的好方法 *zhè zhēn shì yí ge yìxiǎngbúdào de hǎo fāngfǎ* — That really is an unexpectedly good way of doing it.

不 is said with a rising tone before the falling tone of dào: bú dào.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

意想不到 (*yìxiǎngbúdào*) is built from 意 'the mind', 想 'to think', 不 'not' and 到 'to reach', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *'iH*, *sjangX*, *pjut* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): what the mind's thinking does not reach.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìxiǎngbúdào*
- *Say it: yìxiǎngbúdào*, once more
- *Say it: zhè zhēn shì yí ge yìxiǎngbúdào de hǎo fāngfǎ* — That really is an unexpectedly good way of doing it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to look forward to, then the Mandarin for a pleasant surprise, then say *yìxiǎngbúdào* again

Before you move on

What does 意想不到 mean? ("Unexpected; beyond what anyone imagined".) Say it once more.

462.3 hèn — to hate deeply; to resent

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pleasant surprise, then the Mandarin for beyond what anyone imagined.

You'll want to know: hèn

hèn — "to hate deeply; to resent".

nǐ hái hèn tā ma — Do you still hate him?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hèn is inherited from Middle Chinese *honH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'resentment'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hèn*
- *Say it: hèn*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ hái hèn tā ma* — Do you still hate him?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pleasant surprise, then the Mandarin for beyond what anyone imagined, then say *hèn* again

Before you move on

What does hèn mean? ("To hate deeply; to resent".) Say it once more.

462.4 死心 (sǐxīn) — to give up hope

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for beyond what anyone imagined, then the Mandarin for to hate deeply.

You'll want to know: 死心

死心 — *sǐxīn* — "to give up hope".

wǒ děng le tā sān nián xiànzài sǐxīn le — I waited three years for him, and now I've given up.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

死心 (*sǐxīn*) is built from 死 'to die' and 心 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sijX* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as coming to an end: a

heart that has stopped hoping.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǐxīn*
- *Say it: sǐxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ děng le tā sān nián xiànzài sǐxīn le* — I waited three years for him, and now I've given up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for beyond what anyone imagined, then the Mandarin for to hate deeply, then say *sǐxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 死心 mean? ("To give up hope".) Say it once more.

462.5 变心 (biànxīn) — to fall out of love; to stop being faithful

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hate deeply, then the Mandarin for to give up hope.

You'll want to know: 变心

变心 — *biànxīn* — "to fall out of love; to stop being faithful".

他没有变心他还爱你 *tā méiyǒu biànxīn tā hái ài nǐ* — He hasn't fallen out of love with you; he still loves you.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

变心 (*biànxīn*) is built from 变 'to change' and 心 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjenH* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to change'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: biànxīn*
- *Say it: biànxīn*, once more
- *Say it: tā méiyǒu biànxīn tā hái ài nǐ* — He hasn't fallen out of love with you; he still loves you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hate deeply, then the Mandarin for to give up hope, then say *biànxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 变心 mean? ("To fall out of love; to stop being faithful".) Say it once more.

Chapter 463

Scared

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is timid, that something is frightening, ask someone not to scare me and talk about nightmares.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 463: I can say someone is timid, that something is frightening, ask someone not to scare me and talk about nightmares.*

463.1 dǎnxiǎo — timid; easily scared

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give up hope, then the Mandarin for to fall out of love.

You'll want to know: dǎnxiǎo

dǎnxiǎo — "timid; easily scared".

> *wǒ dìdi bǐ wǒ dǎnxiǎo* — My little brother scares more easily than I do.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: dǎn is said with a rising tone before xiǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎnxiǎo is built from *dǎn* 'the gall' and 小 'small', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tamX* and *sjewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first in the pair liver and gall. Courage was thought to sit in the gall, so a small gall is a timid heart; the dictionary does not say so itself.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎnxiǎo*
- *Say it: dǎnxiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dìdi bǐ wǒ dǎnxiǎo* — My little brother scares more easily than I do.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give up hope, then the Mandarin for to fall out of love, then say *dǎnxiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does dǎnxiǎo mean? ("Timid; easily scared".) Say it once more.

463.2 可怕 (kěpà) — frightening; awful

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fall out of love, then the Mandarin for easily scared.

You'll want to know: 可怕

可怕 — *kěpà* — "frightening; awful".

zhège diànyǐng hěn kěpà — This film is really frightening.

The new character, in pieces: 怕 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left the heart piece, a dot, a second dot and a long vertical; on the right 白 *bái*, five strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

可怕 (*kěpà*) is built from 可 'can' and 怕 'to fear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khaX* and *phaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and the second 'to fear'. The dictionary lists 怕 under a second reading, *phaek*, glossed 'still and quiet', which is not this word.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěpà*
- *Say it: kěpà*, once more
- *Say it: zhège diànyǐng hěn kěpà* — This film is really frightening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fall out of love, then the Mandarin for easily scared, then say *kěpà* again

Before you move on

What does 可怕 mean? ("Frightening; awful".) Say it once more.

463.3 怕 — the heart piece, then 白

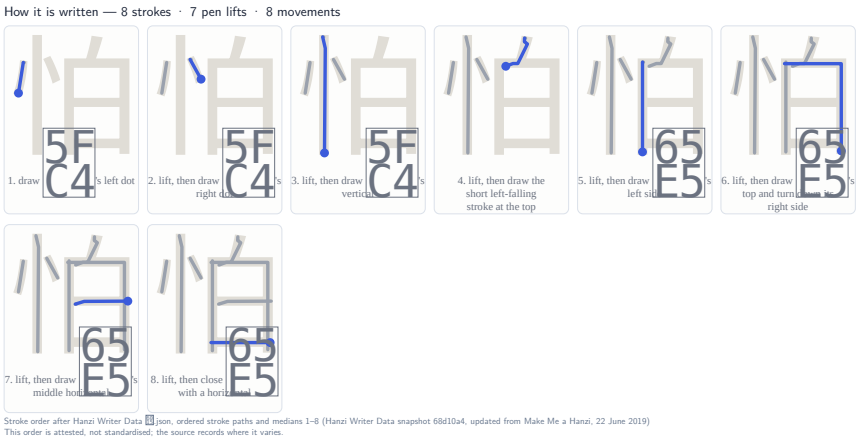
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *kěpà* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  白 情

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bái*, *qíng*

Script — the heart piece, then 白



How 怕 is written, stroke by stroke

怕

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes: the heart piece, as in 情. A short dot on the left, a short dot on the right, then a long vertical down between them.

The right piece, 白, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left at the top, a vertical down the left, a stroke that runs right and turns down, a short bar inside, then the bar across the foot.

3 + 5 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 怕, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 怕 have? (**Two: three strokes and five.**)
Which written character is on the right? (白.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 怕, pinned stroke paths and medians.

463.4 xiàrén — scary; giving people a fright

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for easily scared, then the Mandarin for frightening.

You'll want to know: xiàrén

xiàrén — "scary; giving people a fright".

tiānsè hēi le wàibian yǒudiǎnr xiàrén — It's getting dark, and it's a bit scary outside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàrén is built from *xià* and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xaeH* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under two readings and glosses this one as the sound of laughing; the sense 'to frighten' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàrén*
- *Say it: xiàrén*, once more
- *Say it: tiānsè hēi le wàibian yǒudiǎnr xiàrén* — It's getting dark, and it's a bit scary outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for easily scared, then the Mandarin for frightening, then say *xiàrén* again

Before you move on

What does xiàrén mean? ("Scary; giving people a fright".) Say it once more.

463.5 fādǒu — to tremble; to shiver

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for frightening, then the Mandarin for giving people a fright.

You'll want to know: fādǒu

fādǒu — "to tremble; to shiver".

wàibian hěn lěng wǒ de shǒu zài fādǒu — It's freezing outside, and my hands are shaking.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fādǒu is built from 发 'to set going' and *dǒu* 'to shake', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *tuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to start' and the second as shaking something out.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fādǒu*
- *Say it: fādǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wàibian hěn lěng wǒ de shǒu zài fādǒu* — It's freezing outside, and my hands are shaking.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for frightening, then the Mandarin for giving people a fright, then say *fādǒu* again

Before you move on

What does fādǒu mean? ("To tremble; to shiver".) Say it once more.

463.6 èmèng — nightmare

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for giving people a fright, then the Mandarin for to tremble.

You'll want to know: èmèng

èmèng — "nightmare".

wǒ zuò guo yí ge hěn kěpà de èmèng — I once had a terrifying nightmare.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

èmèng is built from *è* and *mèng* 'a dream', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngak* and *mjuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary gives the first only in the name of a year, and explains the second, after an older book, as the spirit wandering in sleep; the sense 'dreadful' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: èmèng*
- *Say it: èmèng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuò guo yí ge hěn kěpà de èmèng* — I once had a terrifying nightmare.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for giving people a fright, then the Mandarin for to tremble, then say *èmèng* again

Before you move on

What does èmèng mean? ("Nightmare".) Say it once more.

463.7 Looking back: from How I Feel to Scared

Say the Mandarin for one's spirits and to feel for someone.

Your turn

- *Say it:* one's spirits, to feel for someone, thrilled, relaxed and at ease, fed up
- *Say it:* lonely, a matter to deal with, affection between people, what is really on one's mind, hurt by unfair blame
- *Say it:* down in the dumps, to sigh, embarrassed, to sympathize with, to envy
- *Say it:* to hold in high regard, love and care for others, love between a couple, treasured, to look forward to
- *Say it:* a pleasant surprise, beyond what anyone imagined, to hate deeply, to give up hope, to fall out of love
- *Say it:* easily scared, frightening, giving people a fright, to tremble, a nightmare
- *Read it:* 情 爱 怕 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

One's spirits? (*qíngxù.*) To feel for someone? (心疼, *xīnténg.*) Thrilled? (*xīngfèn.*) Relaxed and at ease? (*qīngsōng.*) Fed up? (*fán.*) Lonely? (*gūdān.*) A matter to deal with? (事情, *shìqing.*) Affection between people? (感情, *gǎnqíng.*) What is really on one's mind? (心里话, *xīnlihuà.*) Hurt by unfair blame? (*wěiqu.*) Down in the dumps? (*yùmèn.*) To sigh? (*tànqì.*) Embarrassed? (难为情, *nánwéiqíng.*) To sympathize with? (同情, *tóngqíng.*) To envy? (*xiànmù.*) To hold in high regard? (*pèifú.*) Love and care for others? (爱心, *àixīn.*) Love between a couple? (爱情, *àiqíng.*) Treasured? (心爱, *xīn'ài.*) To look forward to? (*pànwàng.*) A pleasant surprise? (*jīngxǐ.*) Beyond what anyone imagined? (意想不到, *yìxiǎngbúdào.*) To hate deeply? (*hèn.*) To give up hope? (死心, *sǐxīn.*) To fall out of love? (变心, *biànxīn.*) Easily scared? (*dǎnxiǎo.*) Frightening? (可怕, *kěpà.*) Giving people a fright? (*xiàrén.*) To tremble? (*fādǒu.*) A

nightmare? (*èmèng.*)

Chapter 464

Losing My Temper

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone lost their temper or has a hot temper, that someone is infuriating, and that I am furious.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 464: I can say someone lost their temper or has a hot temper, that someone is infuriating, and that I am furious.*

464.1 发火 (fāhuǒ) — to lose one's temper

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to tremble, then the Mandarin for a nightmare.

You'll want to know: 发火

发火 — *fāhuǒ* — "to lose one's temper".

> 他发火的时候我很怕他 *tā fāhuǒ de shíhou wǒ hěn pà tā* — I'm really scared of him when he loses his temper.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

发火 (*fāhuǒ*) is built from 发 'to send out' and 火 'fire', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *xwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to start' and 'to raise'. Anger as a fire that breaks out is the usual explanation, not one the dictionary gives.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāhuǒ*
- *Say it: fāhuǒ*, once more
- *Say it: tā fāhuǒ de shíhou wǒ hěn pà tā* — I'm really scared of him when he loses his temper.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to tremble, then the Mandarin for a nightmare, then say *fāhuǒ* again

Before you move on

What does 发火 mean? ("To lose one's temper".) Say it once more.

464.2 火气 (huǒqì) — temper; anger

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a nightmare, then the Mandarin for to lose one's temper.

You'll want to know: 火气

火气 — *huǒqì* — "temper; anger".

他的火气比我大 *tā de huǒqì bǐ wǒ dà* — He has a worse temper than I do.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

火气 (*huǒqì*) is built from 火 'fire' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwaX* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'breath'. The sense 'anger' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huǒqì*
- *Say it: huǒqì*, once more
- *Say it: tā de huǒqì bǐ wǒ dà* — He has a worse temper than I do.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a nightmare, then the Mandarin for to lose one's temper, then say *huǒqì* again

Before you move on

What does 火气 mean? ("Temper; anger".) Say it once more.

464.3 气人 (qìrén) — to be infuriating; to make people angry

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lose one's temper, then the Mandarin for a hot temper.

You'll want to know: 气人

气人 — *qìrén* — "to be infuriating; to make people angry".

这个人真气人 *zhège rén zhēn qìrén* — That man is really infuriating.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

气人 (*qìrén*) is built from 气 'to anger' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khj+jH* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'breath'; the sense 'to anger' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qìrén*
- *Say it: qìrén*, once more
- *Say it: zhège rén zhēn qìrén* — That man is really infuriating.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lose one's temper, then the Mandarin for a hot temper, then say *qìrén* again

Before you move on

What does 气人 mean? ("To be infuriating; to make people angry".) Say it once more.

464.4 出气 (chūqì) — to vent one's anger; to take it out on someone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hot temper, then the Mandarin for to be infuriating.

You'll want to know: 出气

出气 — *chūqì* — "to vent one's anger; to take it out on someone".

nǐ shēngqì de shíhou bié ná wǒ chūqì — When you get angry, don't take it out on me.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

出气 (*chūqì*) is built from 出 'out' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwit* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'breath'; letting angry breath out is the usual explanation, not one the dictionary gives.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūqì*
- *Say it: chūqì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ shēngqì de shíhou bié ná wǒ chūqì* — When you get angry, don't take it out on me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hot temper, then the Mandarin for to be infuriating, then say *chūqì* again

Before you move on

What does 出气 mean? ("To vent one's anger; to take it out on someone".) Say it once more.

464.5 fènnù — furious; indignant

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be infuriating, then the Mandarin for to take it out on someone.

You'll want to know: fènnù

fènnù — "furious; indignant".

tīng le tā de huà wǒ gǎnjué hěn fènnù — When I heard what he said, I was furious.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fènnù is built from *fèn* and *nù*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjunX* and *nuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'vexed' and the second 'anger'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fènnù*
- *Say it: fènnù*, once more
- *Say it: tīng le tā de huà wǒ gǎnjué hěn fènnù* — When I heard what he said, I was furious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be infuriating, then the Mandarin for to take it out on someone, then say *fènnù* again

Before you move on

What does fènnù mean? ("Furious; indignant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 465

Spoiling the Fun

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say we had a great time, that something spoiled the fun, and talk about being optimistic, gloomy or sure of myself.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 465: I can say we had a great time, that something spoiled the fun, and talk about being optimistic, gloomy or sure of myself.*

465.1 tòngkuài — delighted; to one's heart's content

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take it out on someone, then the Mandarin for furious.

You'll want to know: tòngkuài

tòngkuài — "delighted; to one's heart's content".

> *wǒmen wán le yì tiān wán de hěn tòngkuài* — We spent the whole day having fun and enjoyed every minute of it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tòngkuài is built from *tòng* 'to hurt' and 快 'glad', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thuwngH* and *khwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'illness' and 'to hurt' and the second as what pleases the heart. The sense 'thoroughly' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tòngkuài*
- *Say it: tòngkuài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen wán le yì tiān wán de hěn tòngkuài* — We spent the whole day having fun and enjoyed every minute of it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take it out on someone, then the Mandarin for furious, then say *tòngkuài* again

Before you move on

What does tòngkuài mean? ("Delighted; to one's heart's content".) Say it once more.

465.2 扫兴 (sǎoxìng) — deflated; with the fun spoiled

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for furious, then the Mandarin for to one's heart's content.

You'll want to know: 扫兴

扫兴 — *sǎoxìng* — "deflated; with the fun spoiled".

下雨了真扫兴 *xiàyǔ le zhēn sǎoxìng* — It's raining. What a let-down.

The new character, in pieces: 兴 — six strokes in three pieces: at the top a dot, a second dot and a short stroke falling to the left; a long bar across; and under it 八 *bā*, two strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

扫兴 (*sǎoxìng*) is built from 扫 'to sweep' and 兴 'high spirits', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sawX* and *xingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to sweep away'; it gives the second reading no gloss of its own, so 'high spirits' is the usual explanation, not a settled one.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: sǎoxìng*
- *Say it: sǎoxìng*, once more
- *Say it: xiàyǔ le zhēn sǎoxìng* — It's raining. What a let-down.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for furious, then the Mandarin for to one's heart's content, then say *sǎoxìng* again

Before you move on

What does 扫兴 mean? ("Deflated; with the fun spoiled".) Say it once more.

465.3 兴 — three short strokes over a bar, and 八 under it

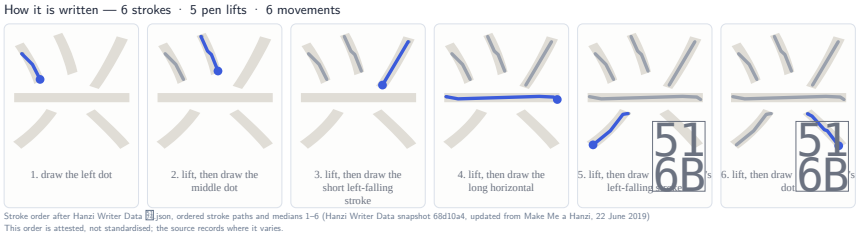
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *sǎoxìng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  八 高

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bā*, *gāo*

Script — three short strokes over a bar, and 丿乀 under it



How 兴 is written, stroke by stroke

兴

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top, three strokes. A dot on the left, a second dot in the middle, both falling to the right, then a short stroke on the right falling to the left.

The bar, one stroke. A long bar across, from left to right, wider than everything above it.

The bottom, 丿乀, two strokes. A stroke falling to the left, then a short stroke falling to the right.

3 + 1 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 兴, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 兴 have? (**Three: three strokes, one and two.**) What is under the bar? (丿乀.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 兴, pinned stroke paths and medians.

465.4 lèguān — optimistic

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to one's heart's content, then the Mandarin for the fun spoiled.

You'll want to know: lèguān

lèguān — "optimistic".

> *wǒ nǎinai shì wǒmen jiā zuì lèguān de rén* — My grandmother is the most optimistic person in our family.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lèguān is built from 乐 'joy' and *guān* 'to view', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lak* and *kwan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'joy' and the second 'to look': looking at things with joy.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: lèguān*
- *Say it: lèguān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nǎinai shì wǒmen jiā zuì lèguān de rén* — My grandmother is the most optimistic person in our family.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to one's heart's content, then the Mandarin for the fun spoiled, then say *lèguān* again

Before you move on

What does lèguān mean? ("Optimistic".) Say it once more.

465.5 bēiguān — pessimistic

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the fun spoiled, then the Mandarin for optimistic.

You'll want to know: bēiguān

bēiguān — "pessimistic".

nǐ bié zhème bēiguān — Don't be so pessimistic.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bēiguān is built from *bēi* 'grief' and *guān* 'to view', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pij* and *kwan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'pain' and the second 'to look'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bēiguān*
- *Say it: bēiguān*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ bié zhème bēiguān* — Don't be so pessimistic.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the fun spoiled, then the Mandarin for optimistic, then say *bēiguān* again

Before you move on

What does bēiguān mean? ("Pessimistic".) Say it once more.

465.6 自信 (zìxìn) — self-confident; sure of oneself

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for optimistic, then the Mandarin for pessimistic.

You'll want to know: 自信

自信 — *zìxìn* — "self-confident; sure of oneself".

看到他这么自信我很高兴 *kàn dào tā zhème zìxìn wǒ hěn gāoxìng* — I'm really glad to see him so sure of himself.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

自信 (*zìxìn*) is built from 自 'self' and 信 'to trust', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *sinH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'from' and the second 'faithful' and 'proof'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìxìn*
- *Say it: zìxìn*, once more
- *Say it: kàn dào tā zhème zìxìn wǒ hěn gāoxìng* — I'm really glad to see him so sure of himself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for optimistic, then the Mandarin for pessimistic, then say *zìxìn* again

Before you move on

What does 自信 mean? ("Self-confident; sure of oneself".) Say it once more.

Chapter 466

Keeping Calm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is lost in thought, tell someone to calm down, talk about my heartbeat, smiles and peace of mind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 466: I can say someone is lost in thought, tell someone to calm down, talk about my heartbeat, smiles and peace of mind.*

466.1 fādāi — to stare blankly; to be lost in a daze

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pessimistic, then the Mandarin for sure of oneself.

You'll want to know: fādāi

fādāi — "to stare blankly; to be lost in a daze".

> *shàngkè de shíhou tā chángcháng fādāi* — In class he's often lost in a daze.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fādāi is built from 发 'to set going' and *dāi* 'dull'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to start'. The dictionary has no entry under the spelling of the second; under a variant spelling it records *ngoj*, glossed 'foolish', which would regularly give *ái*, not *dāi*, so the history of *dāi* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fādāi*
- *Say it: fādāi*, once more
- *Say it: shàngkè de shíhou tā chángcháng fādāi* — In class he's often lost in a daze.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pessimistic, then the Mandarin for sure of oneself, then say *fādāi* again

Before you move on

What does fādāi mean? ("To stare blankly; to be lost in a daze".) Say it once more.

466.2 冷静 (lěngjìng) — calm; cool-headed

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sure of oneself, then the Mandarin for to be lost in a daze.

You'll want to know: 冷静

冷静 — *lěngjìng* — "calm; cool-headed".

你太高兴了先冷静一点儿 *nǐ tài gāoxìng le xiān lěngjìng yìdiǎnr* — You're getting carried away. Calm down a little first.

The new character, in pieces: 靜 — fourteen strokes in two pieces: on the left the right piece of 情, a top of four strokes over 月 *yuè*; on the right a short stroke falling to the left, a bar that turns into a stroke falling to the left, a stroke that runs right and turns down, two bars and a vertical with a hook. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

冷靜 (*lěngjìng*) is built from 冷 'cold' and 靜 'still', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lengX* and *dzjengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'cold' and the second 'at peace'. The dictionary lists 冷 under three readings, two of them glossed 'cold'; *lengX* is one of those two.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: lěngjìng*
- *Say it: lěngjìng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ tài gāoxìng le xiān lěngjìng yìdiǎnr* — You're getting carried away. Calm down a little first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sure of oneself, then the Mandarin for to be lost in a daze, then say *lěngjìng* again

Before you move on

What does 冷靜 mean? ("Calm; cool-headed".) Say it once more.

466.3 靜 — the right piece of 情, then a right side of six

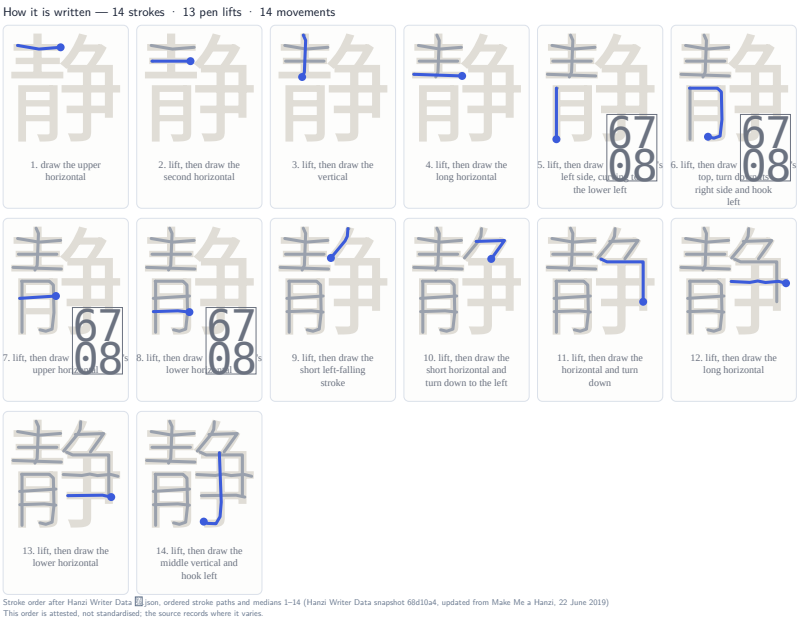
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lěngjìng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

情 冷

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qíng*, *lěng*

Script — the right piece of 情, then a right side of six



How 靜 *is written, stroke by stroke*

靜

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, eight strokes: the right piece of 情. A bar, a second bar, a vertical down through them and a long bar; then 月 under them: the stroke down the left, the stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks, and the two short bars inside.

The right piece, six strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A bar that turns into a stroke falling to the left, like a small roof. A stroke that runs right and turns down. A long bar through it, a second bar under it, then a vertical down the middle that hooks to the left at the foot.

8 + 6 = fourteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 靜, all fourteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 靜 have? (**Two: eight strokes and six.**)
Where have you written the left piece before? (**On the right of 情.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 靜, pinned stroke paths and medians.

466.4 xīntiào — heartbeat

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be lost in a daze, then the Mandarin for cool-headed.

You'll want to know: xīntiào

xīntiào — "heartbeat".

wǒ gǎnjué xīntiào hěn kuài — I can feel my heart racing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīntiào is built from 心 'heart' and *tiào* 'to jump', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *dew* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to leap'. The regular change from *dew* gives a rising tone; how *tiào* came to its falling tone is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīntiào*
- *Say it: xīntiào*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué xīntiào hěn kuài* — I can feel my heart racing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be lost in a daze, then the Mandarin for cool-headed, then say *xīntiào* again

Before you move on

What does xīntiào mean? ("Heartbeat".) Say it once more.

466.5 wēixiào — to give a gentle smile

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cool-headed, then the Mandarin for a heartbeat.

You'll want to know: wēixiào

wēixiào — "to give a gentle smile".

tā wēixiào de shíhou zuì hǎokàn — She looks her best when she smiles.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wēixiào is built from *wēi* 'slight' and 笑 'to laugh', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mj+j* and *sjewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'fine' and 'small' and the second 'glad'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wēixiào*
- *Say it: wēixiào*, once more
- *Say it: tā wēixiào de shíhou zuì hǎokàn* — She looks her best when she smiles.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cool-headed, then the Mandarin for a heartbeat, then say *wēixiào* again

Before you move on

What does wēixiào mean? ("To give a gentle smile".) Say it once more.

466.6 píngjìng — calm; peaceful inside

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a heartbeat, then the Mandarin for to give a gentle smile.

You'll want to know: píngjìng

píngjìng — "calm; peaceful inside".

tīng le yīnyuè yǐhòu wǒ de xīnqíng hěn píngjìng — After listening to some music, I feel at peace.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píngjìng is built from *píng* 'level' and 靜 'still', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaeng* and *dzjengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'straight' and 'calm' and the second 'at peace'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: píngjìng*
- *Say it: píngjìng*, once more
- *Say it: tīng le yīnyuè yǐhòu wǒ de xīnqíng hěn píngjìng* — After listening to some music, I feel at peace.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a heartbeat, then the Mandarin for to give a gentle smile, then say *píngjìng* again

Before you move on

What does píngjìng mean? (“Calm; peaceful inside”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 467

What Kind of Person

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about someone's temper, personality and nature, and say someone is cheerful or lively.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 467: I can talk about someone's temper, personality and nature, and say someone is cheerful or lively.*

467.1 píqi — temper; temperament

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give a gentle smile, then the Mandarin for peaceful inside.

You'll want to know: píqi

píqi — "temper; temperament".

> *wǒ bàba de píqi bǐ wǒ māma hǎo* — My dad is better-tempered than my mum.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píqi is built from *pí* 'the spleen' and *qì* 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjie* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as the organ of earth that helps the stomach. Temper as the breath of the spleen is the usual explanation, not one the dictionary gives.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: píqi*
- *Say it: píqi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba de píqi bǐ wǒ māma hǎo* — My dad is better-tempered than my mum.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give a gentle smile, then the Mandarin for peaceful inside, then say *píqi* again

Before you move on

What does píqi mean? ("Temper; temperament".) Say it once more.

467.2 个性 (gèxìng) — individuality; a strong personality

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for peaceful inside, then the Mandarin for a person's temperament.

You'll want to know: 个性

个性 — *gèxìng* — "individuality; a strong personality".

tā hěn yǒu gèxìng — She has a lot of personality.

The new character, in pieces: 性 — eight strokes in two pieces: on the left the heart piece, a dot, a second dot and a long vertical; on the right 生 *shēng*, five strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

个性 (*gèxìng*) is built from 个 'single' and 性 'nature', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaH* and *sjengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'one-sided' and the second 'nature and conduct'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gèxìng*
- *Say it: gèxìng*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn yǒu gèxìng* — She has a lot of personality.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for peaceful inside, then the Mandarin for a person's temperament, then say *gèxìng* again

Before you move on

What does 个性 mean? ("Individuality; a strong personality".) Say it once more.

467.3 性 — the heart piece, then 生

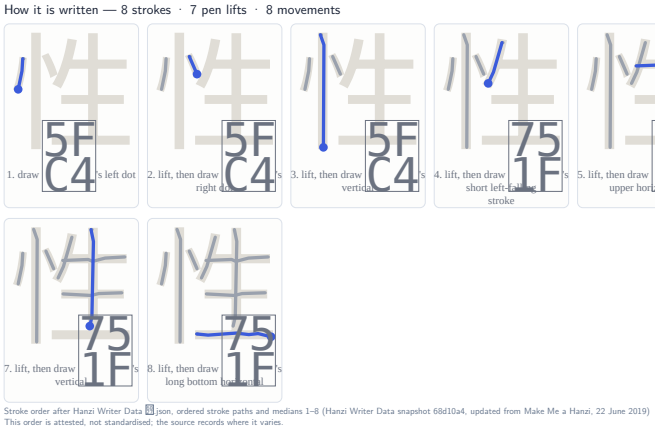
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gèxìng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  生 怕

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shēng*, *pà*

Script — the heart piece, then 生



How 性 is written, stroke by stroke

性

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes: the heart piece. A short dot on the left, a short dot on the right, then a long vertical down between them.

The right piece, 生, five strokes. A short stroke falling to the left at the top, a bar, a second bar, a vertical down through them, then a long bar across the foot.

3 + 5 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 性, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 性 have? (**Two: three strokes and five.**)
Which written character is on the right? (生.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 性, pinned stroke paths and medians.

467.4 天性 (tiānxìng) — one's nature; an inborn trait

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a person's temperament, then the Mandarin for a strong personality.

You'll want to know: 天性

天性 — *tiānxìng* — "one's nature; an inborn trait".

安静是他的天性 *ānjìng shì tā de tiānxìng* — Being quiet is in his nature.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

天性 (*tiānxìng*) is built from 天 'heaven' and 性 'nature', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *then* and *sjengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the dark heaven above' and the second 'nature and conduct': the nature heaven gives.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānxìng*
- *Say it: tiānxìng*, once more
- *Say it: ānjìng shì tā de tiānxìng* — Being quiet is in his nature.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a person's temperament, then the Mandarin for a strong personality, then say *tiānxìng* again

Before you move on

What does 天性 mean? ("One's nature; an inborn trait".) Say it once more.

467.5 kāilǎng — cheerful and outgoing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a strong personality, then the Mandarin for an inborn trait.

You'll want to know: kāilǎng

kāilǎng — "cheerful and outgoing".

wǒ de péngyou lǐ tā zuì kāilǎng — Of all my friends, she's the most cheerful.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāilǎng is built from 开 'to open' and *lǎng* 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *langX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'bright'. The sense of a cheerful nature is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāilǎng*
- *Say it: kāilǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de péngyou lǐ tā zuì kāilǎng* — Of all my friends, she's the most cheerful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a strong personality, then the Mandarin for an inborn trait, then say *kāilǎng* again

Before you move on

What does kāilǎng mean? ("Cheerful and outgoing".) Say it once more.

467.6 huópō — full of life; vivacious

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an inborn trait, then the Mandarin for cheerful and outgoing.

You'll want to know: huópō

huópō — "full of life; vivacious".

wǒ nǚ'ér hěn huópō yě hěn ài xiào — My daughter is very lively and laughs a lot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huópō is built from 活 'alive' and *pō* 'to splash'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'not dead'; no dictionary we use records an older form of the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huópō*
- *Say it: huópō*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nǚ'ér hěn huópō yě hěn ài xiào* — My daughter is very lively and laughs a lot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an inborn trait, then the Mandarin for cheerful and outgoing, then say *huópō* again

Before you move on

What does huópō mean? ("Full of life; vivacious".) Say it once more.

Chapter 468

Good Points

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is kind-hearted, good-natured, strong, hard-working or considerate.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 468: I can say someone is kind-hearted, good-natured, strong, hard-working or considerate.*

468.1 shànliáng — kind-hearted

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for cheerful and outgoing, then the Mandarin for full of life.

You'll want to know: shànliáng

shànliáng — "kind-hearted".

> *wǒ māma shì wǒ rènshi de zuì shànliáng de rén* — My mother is the kindest person I know.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shànliáng is built from *shàn* and *liáng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyenX* and *ljang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each with the other: 'good'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shànliáng*
- *Say it: shànliáng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ māma shì wǒ rènshi de zuì shànliáng de rén* — My mother is the kindest person I know.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for cheerful and outgoing, then the Mandarin for full of life, then say *shànliáng* again

Before you move on

What does shànliáng mean? ("Kind-hearted".) Say it once more.

468.2 和气 (héqi) — good-natured; pleasant to deal with

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for full of life, then the Mandarin for kind-hearted.

You'll want to know: 和气

和气 — *héqi* — "good-natured; pleasant to deal with".

他很安静对人也很和气 *tā hěn ānjìng duì rén yě hěn héqi* — He's quiet, and he's pleasant to everyone too.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

和气 (*héqi*) is built from 和 'harmony' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwa* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'in tune' and 'neither hard nor soft'. The second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: héqi*
- *Say it: héqi*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn ānjìng duì rén yě hěn héqi* — He's quiet, and he's pleasant to everyone too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for full of life, then the Mandarin for kind-hearted, then say *héqi* again

Before you move on

What does 和气 mean? ("Good-natured; pleasant to deal with".) Say it once more.

468.3 jiānqiáng — strong; tough (in spirit)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for kind-hearted, then the Mandarin for pleasant to deal with.

You'll want to know: jiānqiáng

jiānqiáng — "strong; tough (in spirit)".

tā bìng le liǎng nián kěshì tā hěn jiānqiáng — She has been ill for two years, but she's very strong.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiānqiáng is built from *jiān* 'firm' and *qiáng* 'strong', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ken* and *gjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'firm' and the second 'healthy' and 'strong'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiānqiáng*
- *Say it: jiānqiáng*, once more
- *Say it: tā bìng le liǎng nián kěshì tā hěn jiānqiáng* — She has been ill for two years, but she's very strong.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for kind-hearted, then the Mandarin for pleasant to deal with, then say *jiānqiáng* again

Before you move on

What does jiānqiáng mean? ("Strong; tough (in spirit)".) Say it once more.

468.4 qínkuài — diligent with chores; quick to pitch in

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pleasant to deal with, then the Mandarin for strong in spirit.

You'll want to know: qínkuài

qínkuài — "diligent with chores; quick to pitch in".

tā bǐ tā gēge qínkuài — He's more hard-working than his big brother.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qínkuài is built from *qín* 'toil' and 快 'quick', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gj+n* and *khwaejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'toil' and the second as what pleases the heart; the sense 'quick' for the second is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qínkuài*
- *Say it: qínkuài*, once more
- *Say it: tā bǐ tā gēge qínkuài* — He's more hard-working than his big brother.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pleasant to deal with, then the Mandarin for strong in spirit, then say *qínkuài* again

Before you move on

What does qínkuài mean? ("Diligent with chores; quick to pitch in".) Say it once more.

468.5 tǐtiē — considerate; thoughtful of others' needs

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for strong in spirit, then the Mandarin for quick to pitch in.

You'll want to know: tǐtiē

tǐtiē — "considerate; thoughtful of others' needs".

wǒ bìng de shíhou tā duì wǒ hěn tǐtiē — When I was ill, he was very considerate to me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǐtiē is built from 体 'body' and *tiē* 'to stick to', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *thep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'the body' and the second as pawning a thing for money; the sense 'considerate' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐtiē*
- *Say it: tǐtiē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bìng de shíhou tā duì wǒ hěn tǐtiē* — When I was ill, he was very considerate to me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for strong in spirit, then the Mandarin for quick to pitch in, then say *tǐtiē* again

Before you move on

What does tǐtiē mean? ("Considerate; thoughtful of others' needs".) Say it once more.

Chapter 469

Gentle and Steady

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is impulsive, gentle, decent or steady, and that someone is an impatient sort.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 469: I can say someone is impulsive, gentle, decent or steady, and that someone is an impatient sort.*

469.1 chōngdòng — impulsive; rash

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for quick to pitch in, then the Mandarin for thoughtful of others' needs.

You'll want to know: chōngdòng

chōngdòng — "impulsive; rash".

> *tā tài chōngdòng le chángcháng shuō cuò huà* — He's too impulsive and often says the wrong thing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chōngdòng is built from *chōng* 'to dash against' and *dòng* 'to move', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhowng* and *duwngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rush at' and the second 'restless' and 'to move'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chōngdòng*
- *Say it: chōngdòng*, once more
- *Say it: tā tài chōngdòng le chángcháng shuō cuò huà* — He's too impulsive and often says the wrong thing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for quick to pitch in, then the Mandarin for thoughtful of others' needs, then say *chōngdòng* again

Before you move on

What does chōngdòng mean? ("Impulsive; rash".) Say it once more.

469.2 温和 (wēnhé) — gentle in manner; soft-spoken

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for thoughtful of others' needs, then the Mandarin for impulsive.

You'll want to know: 温和

温和 — *wēnhé* — "gentle in manner; soft-spoken".

他的个性比我温和 *tā de gèxìng bǐ wǒ wēnhé* — He has a gentler nature than I do.

The new character, in pieces: 温 — twelve strokes in three pieces: on the left the water piece, a dot, a second dot and a rising stroke; at the top right 日 *rì*, four strokes; at the foot a dish of five strokes, a vertical, a stroke that runs right and turns down, two short verticals and a bar. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

温和 (*wēnhé*) is built from 温 'warm' and 和 'harmony', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'won* and *hwa* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'mild', 'good', 'soft' and 'warm' and the second 'in tune'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wēnhé*
- *Say it: wēnhé*, once more
- *Say it: tā de gèxìng bǐ wǒ wēnhé* — He has a gentler nature than I do.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for thoughtful of others' needs, then the Mandarin for impulsive, then say *wēnhé* again

Before you move on

What does 温和 mean? ("Gentle in manner; soft-spoken".) Say it once more.

469.3 温 — the water piece, then 日 over a dish

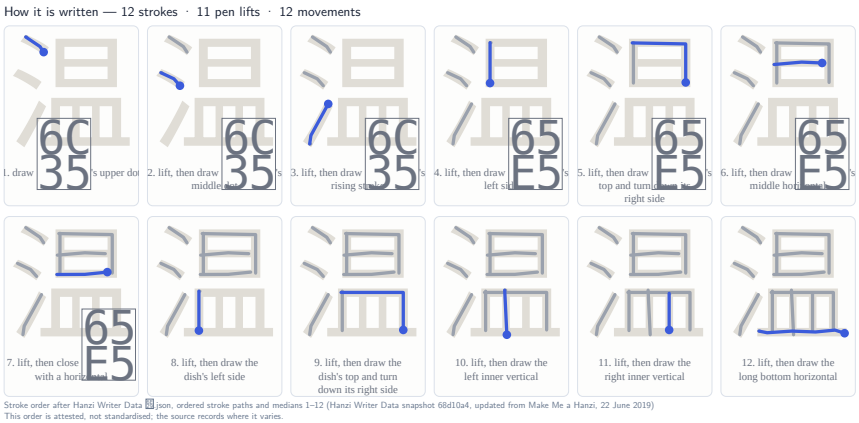
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wēnhé* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

汉 日 和

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hàn*, *rì*, *hé*

Script — the water piece, then 日 over a dish



How 温 is written, stroke by stroke

温

Three pieces: the left, then the top right, then the foot. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, three strokes: the water piece, as in 汉. A dot, a second dot under it, then a stroke that rises from the bottom left up to the right.

The top right, 日, four strokes. A vertical down the left, a stroke that runs right and turns down, a bar inside, then the bar across the foot.

The foot, a dish, five strokes. A short vertical on the left, a stroke that runs right and turns down, two short verticals inside, then a long bar across the bottom, under everything.

3 + 4 + 5 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 温, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 温 have? (**Three: three strokes, four and five.**) Which written character sits at the top right? (日.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 温, pinned stroke paths and medians.

469.4 正经 (zhèngjīng) — decent; serious and proper

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for impulsive, then the Mandarin for gentle in manner.

You'll want to know: 正经

正经 — *zhèngjīng* — "decent; serious and proper".

他是一个很正经的人 *tā shì yí ge hěn zhèngjīng de rén* — He's a very decent man.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

正经 (*zhèngjīng*) is built from 正 'straight' and 经 'the warp thread', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengH* and *keng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'right' and 'proper' and the second 'constant' and as the warp of cloth. The sense 'decent' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhèngjīng*
- *Say it: zhèngjīng*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì yí ge hěn zhèngjīng de rén* — He's a very decent man.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for impulsive, then the Mandarin for gentle in manner, then say *zhèngjīng* again

Before you move on

What does 正经 mean? ("Decent; serious and proper".) Say it once more.

469.5 wěnzhòng — steady; calm and reliable

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for gentle in manner, then the Mandarin for decent and proper.

You'll want to know: wěnzhòng

wěnzhòng — "steady; calm and reliable".

tā bǐ tā jiějie wěnzhòng — She's steadier than her big sister.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wěnzhòng is built from *wěn* 'settled' and 重 'heavy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'wonX* and *drjowngX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as grain gathered and 'safe and settled', and the second 'thick' and 'careful'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wěnzhòng*
- *Say it: wěnzhòng*, once more
- *Say it: tā bǐ tā jiějie wěnzhòng* — She's steadier than her big sister.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for gentle in manner, then the Mandarin for decent and proper, then say *wěnzhòng* again

Before you move on

What does wěnzhòng mean? ("Steady; calm and reliable".) Say it once more.

469.6 jíxìngzi — an impatient sort; a hothead

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for decent and proper, then the Mandarin for steady and reliable.

You'll want to know: jíxìngzi

jíxìngzi — "an impatient sort; a hothead".

wǒ bàba shì ge jíxìngzi — My dad is the impatient sort.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jíxìngzi is built from *jí* 'hasty', 性 'nature' and 子, a noun ending, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *kip*, *sjengH* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'urgent' and 'quick'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jíxìngzi*
- *Say it: jíxìngzi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba shì ge jíxìngzi* — My dad is the impatient sort.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for decent and proper, then the Mandarin for steady and reliable, then say *jíxìngzi* again

Before you move on

What does jíxìngzi mean? ("An impatient sort; a hothead".) Say it once more.

469.7 Looking back: from Losing My Temper to Gentle and Steady

Say the Mandarin for to lose one's temper and a hot temper.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to lose one's temper, a hot temper, to be infuriating, to take it out on someone, furious
- *Say it:* to one's heart's content, the fun spoiled, optimistic, pessimistic, sure of oneself
- *Say it:* to be lost in a daze, cool-headed, a heartbeat, to give a gentle smile, peaceful inside
- *Say it:* a person's temperament, a strong personality, an inborn trait, cheerful and outgoing, full of life
- *Say it:* kind-hearted, pleasant to deal with, strong in spirit, quick to pitch in, thoughtful of others' needs
- *Say it:* impulsive, gentle in manner, decent and proper, steady and reliable, an impatient sort
- *Read it:* 兴 静 性 温 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To lose one's temper? (发火, *fāhuǒ.*) A hot temper? (火气, *huǒqì.*) To be infuriating? (气人, *qìrén.*) To take it out on someone? (出气, *chūqì.*) Furious? (*fènnù.*) To one's heart's content? (*tòngkuài.*) The fun spoiled? (扫兴, *sǎoxìng.*) Optimistic? (*lèguān.*) Pessimistic? (*bēiguān.*) Sure of oneself? (自信, *zìxìn.*) To be lost in a daze? (*fādāi.*) Cool-headed? (冷静, *lěngjìng.*) A heartbeat? (*xīntiào.*) To give a gentle smile? (*wēixiào.*) Peaceful inside? (*píngjìng.*) A

person's temperament? (*píqi.*) A strong personality? (个性, *gèxìng.*) An inborn trait? (天性, *tiānxìng.*) Cheerful and outgoing? (*kāilǎng.*) Full of life? (*huópō.*) Kind-hearted? (*shànliáng.*) Pleasant to deal with? (和气, *héqi.*) Strong in spirit? (*jiānqiáng.*) Quick to pitch in? (*qínkuài.*) Thoughtful of others' needs? (*tǐtiē.*) Impulsive? (*chōngdòng.*) Gentle in manner? (温和, *wēnhé.*) Decent and proper? (正经, *zhèngjīng.*) Steady and reliable? (*wěnzhòng.*) An impatient sort? (*jíxìngzi.*)

Chapter 470

Faults

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is selfish, stubborn, a bit full of himself or sloppy, and that I feel stupid.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 470: I can say someone is selfish, stubborn, a bit full of himself or sloppy, and that I feel stupid.*

470.1 zìsī — selfish

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for steady and reliable, then the Mandarin for an impatient sort.

You'll want to know: zìsī

zìsī — "selfish".

> *wǒ zuì bù xǐhuan zìsī de rén* — Selfish people are the ones I like least.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zìsī is built from 自 'self' and *sī* 'private', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *sij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'not public'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìsī*
- *Say it: zìsī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì bù xǐhuan zìsī de rén* — Selfish people are the ones I like least.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for steady and reliable, then the Mandarin for an impatient sort, then say *zìsī* again

Before you move on

What does zìsī mean? ("Selfish".) Say it once more.

470.2 gùzhí — stubborn

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an impatient sort, then the Mandarin for selfish.

You'll want to know: gùzhí

gùzhí — "stubborn".

wǒ yéye bǐ wǒ nǎinai gùzhí — My grandfather is more stubborn than my grandmother.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gùzhí is built from *gù* 'firm' and *zhí* 'to hold', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuH* and *tsyip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'firm' and the second 'to hold' and 'to keep': holding on to one's view.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gùzhí*
- *Say it: gùzhí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yéye bǐ wǒ nǎinai gùzhí* — My grandfather is more stubborn than my grandmother.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an impatient sort, then the Mandarin for selfish, then say *gùzhí* again

Before you move on

What does gùzhí mean? ("Stubborn".) Say it once more.

470.3 jiāo'ào — proud; full of oneself

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for selfish, then the Mandarin for stubborn.

You'll want to know: jiāo'ào

jiāo'ào — "proud; full of oneself".

tā hěn cōngming kěshì yǒudiǎnr jiāo'ào — He's very clever, but a bit full of himself.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāo'ào is built from *jiāo* and *ào* 'haughty', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjew* and *ngawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as a horse six feet tall and the second 'arrogant'; the sense 'proud' for the first is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāo'ào*
- *Say it: jiāo'ào*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn cōngming kěshì yǒudiǎnr jiāo'ào* — He's very clever, but a bit full of himself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for selfish, then the Mandarin for stubborn, then say *jiāo'ào* again

Before you move on

What does jiāo'ào mean? ("Proud; full of oneself".) Say it once more.

470.4 mǎhu — sloppy; slapdash

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for stubborn, then the Mandarin for full of oneself.

You'll want to know: mǎhu

mǎhu — "sloppy; slapdash".

tā zuò zuòyè hěn mǎhu — He's slapdash about his homework.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǎhu is built from 马 'horse' and *hǔ* 'tiger', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maeX* and *xuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). How a horse and a tiger came to mean 'careless' is not settled; the second syllable is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎhu*
- *Say it: mǎhu*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuò zuòyè hěn mǎhu* — He's slapdash about his homework.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for stubborn, then the Mandarin for full of oneself, then say *mǎhu* again

Before you move on

What does mǎhu mean? ("Sloppy; slapdash".) Say it once more.

470.5 bèn — slow-witted; clumsy

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for full of oneself, then the Mandarin for slapdash.

You'll want to know: bèn

bèn — "slow-witted; clumsy".

wǒ gǎnjué zìjǐ hěn bèn — I feel really stupid.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bèn is inherited from Middle Chinese *bwonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as the inside of a bamboo stem; the dictionary also records a fat man nicknamed with this word. The sense 'stupid' is not given there, so how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bèn*
- *Say it: bèn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué zìjǐ hěn bèn* — I feel really stupid.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for full of oneself, then the Mandarin for slapdash, then say *bèn* again

Before you move on

What does bèn mean? ("Slow-witted; clumsy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 471

Eyes

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about tears, what is right in front of me, petty people, being short-sighted and a wink.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 471: I can talk about tears, what is right in front of me, petty people, being short-sighted and a wink.*

471.1 yǎnlèi — tears

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for slapdash, then the Mandarin for slow-witted.

You'll want to know: yǎnlèi

yǎnlèi — "tears".

> *wǒ dì-yī cì kàn dào bàba de yǎnlèi* — It was the first time I had seen my dad in tears.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎnlèi is built from *yǎn* 'eye' and *lèi* 'tears', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngeanX* and *lwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the eye' and the second 'tears'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnlèi*
- *Say it: yǎnlèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dì-yī cì kàn dào bàba de yǎnlèi* — It was the first time I had seen my dad in tears.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for slapdash, then the Mandarin for slow-witted, then say *yǎnlèi* again

Before you move on

What does yǎnlèi mean? ("Tears".) Say it once more.

471.2 眼前 (yǎnqián) — before one's eyes; right now

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for slow-witted, then the Mandarin for tears.

You'll want to know: 眼前

眼前 — *yǎnqián* — "before one's eyes; right now".

那个事故发生在我眼前 *nàge shìgù fāshēng zài wǒ yǎnqián* — That accident happened right in front of my eyes.

The new character, in pieces: 眼 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left an eye, five strokes, like 日 *rì* with one bar more; on the right six strokes, a stroke that runs right and turns down, two bars, a vertical that turns up at the foot, a short stroke falling to the left and a long one falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

眼前 (*yǎnqián*) is built from 眼 'eye' and 前 'in front', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngeanX* and *dzen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the eye' and the second 'before'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnqián*
- *Say it: yǎnqián*, once more
- *Say it: nàge shìgù fāshēng zài wǒ yǎnqián* — That accident happened right in front of my eyes.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for slow-witted, then the Mandarin for tears, then say *yǎnqián* again

Before you move on

What does 眼前 mean? ("Before one's eyes; right now".) Say it once more.

471.3 眼 — an eye, then a right side of six

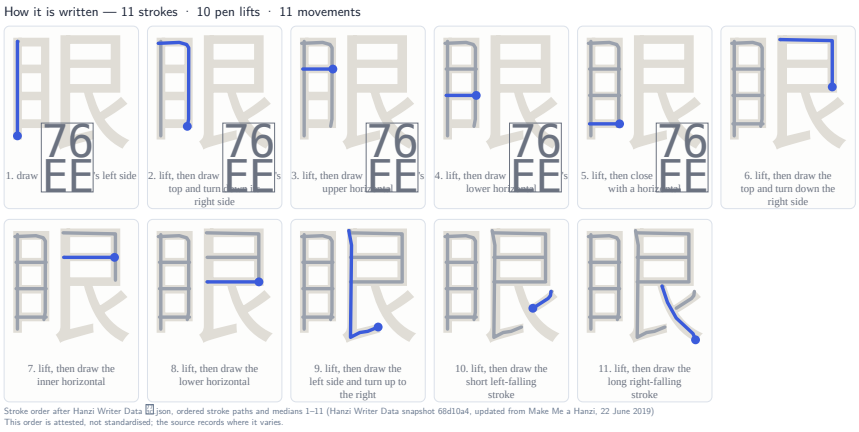
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yǎnqián* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  日 前

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rì*, *qián*

Script — an eye, then a right side of six



How 眼 *is written, stroke by stroke*

眼

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the eye, five strokes. Like 日, made tall and narrow, with one bar more: a vertical down the left, a stroke that runs right and turns down, two short bars inside, then the bar across the foot.

The right piece, six strokes. A stroke that runs right and turns down. A bar inside, and a second one under it. Then a vertical down the left that turns up to the right at the foot, a short stroke falling to the left, and last a long stroke falling to the right.

5 + 6 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 眼, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 眼 have? (**Two: five strokes and six.**)
What is the left piece like? (**日, with one bar more.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 眼, pinned stroke paths and medians.

471.4 小心眼 (xiǎoxīnyǎn) — petty; narrow-minded

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for tears, then the Mandarin for right before one's eyes.

You'll want to know: 小心眼

小心眼 — *xiǎoxīnyǎn* — "petty; narrow-minded".

他有点儿小心眼 *tā yǒudiǎnr xiǎoxīnyǎn* — He's a bit petty.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

小心眼 (*xiǎoxīnyǎn*) is built from 小 'small', 心 'heart' and 眼 'eye', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX*, *sim* and *ngeanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): a heart with a small eye, which sees only small things.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎoxīnyǎn*
- *Say it: xiǎoxīnyǎn*, once more
- *Say it: tā yǒudiǎnr xiǎoxīnyǎn* — He's a bit petty.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for tears, then the Mandarin for right before one's eyes, then say *xiǎoxīnyǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 小心眼 mean? ("Petty; narrow-minded".) Say it once more.

471.5 jìnshì — short-sighted

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for right before one's eyes, then the Mandarin for petty and narrow-minded.

You'll want to know: jìnshì

jìnshì — "short-sighted".

> *wǒ gǎnjué yǎnjing bú tài hǎo kěnéng jìnshì le* — My eyes don't feel right; I might be getting short-sighted.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jìnshì is built from *jìn* 'near' and *shì* 'to look', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gj+nX* and *dzyijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'close by' and the second 'to view'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnshì*
- *Say it: jìnshì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué yǎnjing bú tài hǎo kěnéng jìnshì le* — My eyes don't feel right; I might be getting short-sighted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for right before one's eyes, then the Mandarin for petty and narrow-minded, then say *jìnshì* again

Before you move on

What does jìnshì mean? ("Short-sighted".) Say it once more.

471.6 zhǎyǎn — to blink; to wink

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for petty and narrow-minded, then the Mandarin for short-sighted.

You'll want to know: zhǎyǎn

zhǎyǎn — "to blink; to wink".

> *tā duì wǒ zhǎyǎn* — He winked at me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: zhǎ is said with a rising tone before yǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǎyǎn is built from *zhǎ* and 眼 'eye', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsreap* and *ngeanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the eye moving'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎyǎn*
- *Say it: zhǎyǎn*, once more
- *Say it: tā duì wǒ zhǎyǎn* — He winked at me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for petty and narrow-minded, then the Mandarin for short-sighted, then say *zhǎyǎn* again

Before you move on

What does zhǎyǎn mean? ("To blink; to wink".) Say it once more.

Chapter 472

Faces

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about eyebrows, how someone looks, someone turning nasty, a facial expression and a hot forehead.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 472: I can talk about eyebrows, how someone looks, someone turning nasty, a facial expression and a hot forehead.*

472.1 méimao — eyebrow

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for short-sighted, then the Mandarin for to wink.

You'll want to know: méimao

méimao — "eyebrow".

> *tā de méimao bǐ wǒ de hēi* — His eyebrows are darker than mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

méimao is built from *méi* 'the brow' and *máo* 'hair', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mij* and *maw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older book, as the hair above the eye; the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: méimao*
- *Say it: méimao*, once more
- *Say it: tā de méimao bǐ wǒ de hēi* — His eyebrows are darker than mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for short-sighted, then the Mandarin for to wink, then say *méimao* again

Before you move on

What does méimao mean? ("Eyebrow".) Say it once more.

472.2 脸色 (liǎnsè) — complexion; the colour of one's face

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wink, then the Mandarin for an eyebrow.

You'll want to know: 脸色

脸色 — *liǎnsè* — "complexion; the colour of one's face".

> 你脸色不好是不是病了 *nǐ liǎnsè bù hǎo shì bu shì bìng le* — You don't look well. Are you ill?

The new character, in pieces: 脸 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left 月 *yuè*, four strokes; on the right seven, as on the right of 检 *jiǎn*: a long stroke falling to the left and one falling to the right, a short bar, two dots, a short stroke falling to the left and a long bar. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

脸色 (*liǎnsè*) is built from 脸 'face' and 色 'colour', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *leamX* and *srik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under two readings, *tshjem* and *leamX*, and glosses *leamX* as a kind of stew; neither gloss is the face, so how it came to mean face is not settled. It glosses the second 'colour of the face'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: liǎnsè*
- *Say it: liǎnsè*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ liǎnsè bù hǎo shì bu shì bìng le* — You don't look well. Are you ill?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wink, then the Mandarin for an eyebrow, then say *liǎnsè* again

Before you move on

What does 脸色 mean? ("Complexion; the colour of one's face".) Say it once more.

472.3 脸 — 月, then the right piece of 检

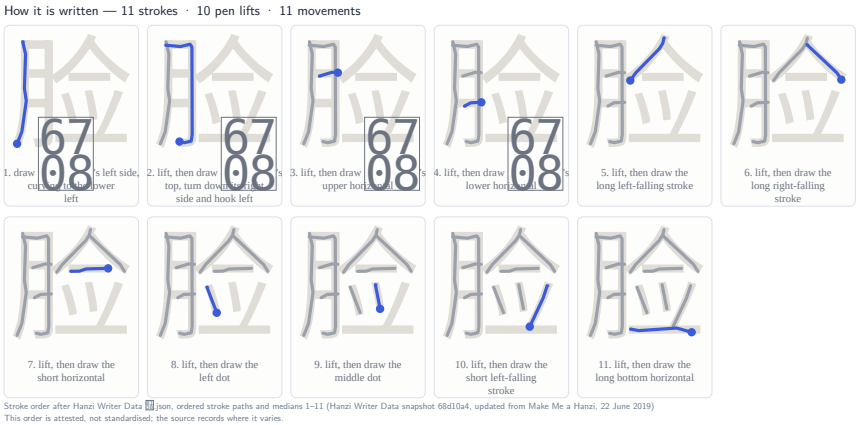
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *liǎnsè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  检 色

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jiǎn*, *sè*

Script — 月, then the right piece of 检



How 脸 is written, stroke by stroke

脸

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 月, four strokes, narrow. The stroke down the left that curves to the left at the foot, the stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks, then two short bars inside.

The right piece, seven strokes, as on the right of 检. A long stroke falling to the left and a long one falling to the right, like a roof. A short bar under them. Two short dots and a short stroke falling to the left. Then a long bar across the foot.

4 + 7 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 脸, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 脸 have? (**Two: four strokes and seven.**) Where have you written the right piece before? (**On the right of 检.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 脸, pinned stroke paths and medians.

472.4 变脸 (biànliǎn) — to turn hostile suddenly; to change one's attitude abruptly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an eyebrow, then the Mandarin for the colour of one's face.

You'll want to know: 变脸

变脸 — *biànliǎn* — "to turn hostile suddenly; to change one's attitude abruptly".

我没说什么他怎么突然变脸了 *wǒ méi shuō shénme tā zěnme tūrán biànliǎn le* — I didn't say anything, so why has he suddenly turned nasty?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

变脸 (*biànliǎn*) is built from 变 'to change' and 脸 'face', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjenH* and *leamX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to change'. The sense of a sudden change of attitude is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: biànliǎn*
- *Say it: biànliǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ méi shuō shénme tā zěnme tūrán biànliǎn le* — I didn't say anything, so why has he suddenly turned nasty?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an eyebrow, then the Mandarin for the colour of one's face, then say *biànliǎn* again

Before you move on

What does 变脸 mean? ("To turn hostile suddenly; to change one's attitude abruptly".) Say it once more.

472.5 biǎoqíng — facial expression; the look on one's face

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the colour of one's face, then the Mandarin for to turn hostile suddenly.

You'll want to know: biǎoqíng

biǎoqíng — "facial expression; the look on one's face".

kàn tā de biǎoqíng wǒ gǎnjué tā bú tài gāoxìng — From the look on his face, I get the feeling he's not very happy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

biǎoqíng is built from *biǎo* 'the outside' and 情 'feeling', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjewX* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to make clear' and, after an older book, as an outer garment: feeling shown on the outside.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: biǎoqíng*
- *Say it: biǎoqíng*, once more
- *Say it: kàn tā de biǎoqíng wǒ gǎnjué tā bú tài gāoxìng* — From the look on his face, I get the feeling he's not very happy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the colour of one's face, then the Mandarin for to turn hostile suddenly, then say *biǎoqíng* again

Before you move on

What does biǎoqíng mean? ("Facial expression; the look on one's face".) Say it once more.

472.6 étóu — forehead

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to turn hostile suddenly, then the Mandarin for the look on one's face.

You'll want to know: étóu

étóu — "forehead".

wǒ de étóu hěn rè kěnéng fāshāo le — My forehead's hot. I might have a temperature.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

étóu is built from *é* 'the forehead' and 头 'head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngaek* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as the brow.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: étóu*
- *Say it: étóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de étóu hěn rè kěnéng fāshāo le* — My forehead's hot. I might have a temperature.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to turn hostile suddenly, then the Mandarin for the look on one's face, then say *étóu* again

Before you move on

What does étóu mean? (“Forehead”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 473

At the Dentist

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my mouth, my dentist and my teeth, and having a tooth out or filled.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 473: I can talk about my mouth, my dentist and my teeth, and having a tooth out or filled.*

473.1 zuǐ — mouth; beak

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the look on one's face, then the Mandarin for the forehead.

You'll want to know: zuǐ

zuǐ — "mouth; beak".

> *zhège cài tài là le wǒ de zuǐ hěn nánshòu* — This dish is so hot my mouth is burning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

zuǐ is the everyday word for the mouth; 口 *kǒu* mostly appears inside other words, as in *rùkǒu* 'entrance'.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuǐ No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuǐ*
- *Say it: zuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: zhège cài tài là le wǒ de zuǐ hěn nánshòu* — This dish is so hot my mouth is burning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the look on one's face, then the Mandarin for the forehead, then say *zuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does zuǐ mean? ("Mouth; beak".) Say it once more.

473.2 牙医 (yáyī) — dentist

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the forehead, then the Mandarin for the mouth.

You'll want to know: 牙医

牙医 — *yáyī* — "dentist".

我的牙医很和气 *wǒ de yáyī hěn héqi* — My dentist is very nice.

The new character, in pieces: 牙 — four strokes: a short bar on top; a short stroke down on the left that turns and runs right; a vertical that hooks to the left at the foot; and a long stroke falling to the left. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

牙医 (*yáyī*) is built from 牙 'tooth' and 医 'doctor', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngae* and *'i* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'teeth' and the second 'to heal'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yáyī*
- *Say it: yáyī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de yáyī hěn héqi* — My dentist is very nice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the forehead, then the Mandarin for the mouth, then say *yáyī* again

Before you move on

What does 牙医 mean? ("Dentist".) Say it once more.

473.3 牙 — four strokes, each one different

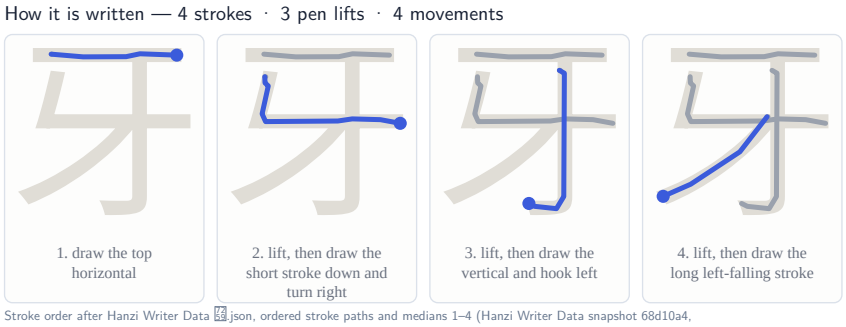
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yáyī* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  医 口

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yī*, *kǒu*

Script — four strokes, each one different



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 牙.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–4 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 牙 is written, stroke by stroke

牙

One piece of four strokes. Count them as you go.

The first two. A short bar along the top, from left to right. Then under it on the left a short stroke down that turns and runs right, longer than the bar.

The last two. A vertical from the top bar down through the second stroke, hooking to the left at the foot. Then a long stroke falling to the left, from the middle down to the bottom left.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 牙, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 牙 have? (**Four**.) Which comes last? (**The long stroke falling to the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 牙, pinned stroke paths and medians.

473.4 yáchǐ — tooth; teeth

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the mouth, then the Mandarin for a dentist.

You'll want to know: yáchǐ

yáchǐ — "tooth; teeth".

tā de yáchǐ bǐ wǒ de bái — His teeth are whiter than mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yáchǐ is built from 牙 and *chǐ*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngae* and *tsyhiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each with this very word: 'teeth'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yáchǐ*
- *Say it: yáchǐ*, once more
- *Say it: tā de yáchǐ bǐ wǒ de bái* — His teeth are whiter than mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the mouth, then the Mandarin for a dentist, then say *yáchǐ* again

Before you move on

What does yáchǐ mean? ("Tooth; teeth".) Say it once more.

473.5 báyá — to have a tooth pulled

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a dentist, then the Mandarin for the teeth.

You'll want to know: báyá

báyá — "to have a tooth pulled".

wǒ jīntiān qù báyá le xiànzài hái hěn téng — I had a tooth out today, and it still really hurts.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

báyá is built from *bá* 'to pull up' and 牙 'tooth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *beat* and *ngae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under three readings and glosses this one 'to pull up' and 'to promote'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: báyá*
- *Say it: báyá*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ jīntiān qù báyá le xiànzài hái hěn téng* — I had a tooth out today, and it still really hurts.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a dentist, then the Mandarin for the teeth, then say *báyá* again

Before you move on

What does báyá mean? ("To have a tooth pulled".) Say it once more.

473.6 bǔyá — to have a tooth filled

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the teeth, then the Mandarin for to have a tooth pulled.

You'll want to know: bǔyá

bǔyá — "to have a tooth filled".

wǒ zuì pà bǔyá — Having a filling is what I dread most.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǔyá is built from *bǔ* 'to patch' and 牙 'tooth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *puX* and *ngae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to mend' and, after an older book, mending clothes.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǔyá*
- *Say it: bǔyá*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì pà bǔyá* — Having a filling is what I dread most.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the teeth, then the Mandarin for to have a tooth pulled, then say *bǔyá* again

Before you move on

What does bǔyá mean? ("To have a tooth filled".) Say it once more.

Chapter 474

Strength

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my arms and fingers, how strong someone is, their stamina, and pressing hard.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 474: I can talk about my arms and fingers, how strong someone is, their stamina, and pressing hard.*

474.1 gēbo — arm

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a tooth pulled, then the Mandarin for to have a tooth filled.

You'll want to know: gēbo

gēbo — "arm".

> *wǒ gōngzuò le shí ge xiǎoshí gēbo hěn téng* — I worked for ten hours, and my arms really ache.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēbo is built from *gē* and *bo*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kak* and *phak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the armpit and the second as dried meat; how the pair came to mean the arm is not settled, and the first tone of *gē* is irregular.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēbo*
- *Say it: gēbo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gōngzuò le shí ge xiǎoshí gēbo hěn téng* — I worked for ten hours, and my arms really ache.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a tooth pulled, then the Mandarin for to have a tooth filled, then say *gēbo* again

Before you move on

What does gēbo mean? ("Arm".) Say it once more.

474.2 力气 (lìqi) — physical strength

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a tooth filled, then the Mandarin for the arm.

You'll want to know: 力气

力气 — *lìqi* — "physical strength".

他的力气比我大 *tā de lìqi bǐ wǒ dà* — He's stronger than I am.

The new character, in pieces: 力 — two strokes: a stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks to the left, and a long stroke falling to the left through it. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

力气 (*lìqi*) is built from 力 'strength' and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lik* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'sinew' and the second 'breath'; the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: lìqi*
- *Say it: lìqi*, once more
- *Say it: tā de lìqi bǐ wǒ dà* — He's stronger than I am.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a tooth filled, then the Mandarin for the arm, then say *lìqi* again

Before you move on

What does 力气 mean? ("Physical strength".) Say it once more.

474.3 力 — a turn with a hook, then a falling stroke

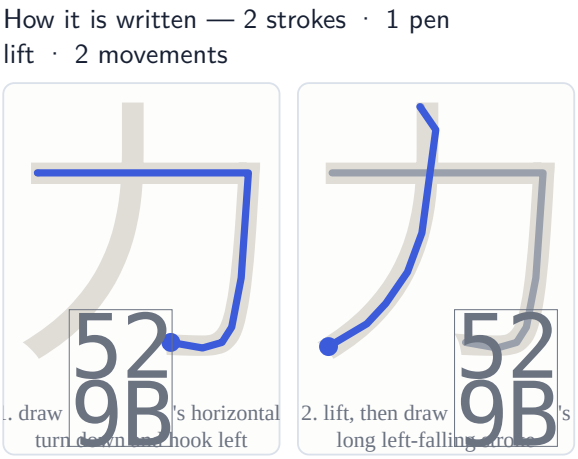
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *lìqi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  男 气

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nán*, *qì*

Script — a turn with a hook, then a falling stroke



Stroke order after Hanzi Writer Data 52/9B.json, ordered stroke paths and medians 1–2 (Hanzi Writer Data snapshot 68d10a4, updated from Make Me a Hanzi, 22 June 2019)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How 力 is written, stroke by stroke

力

One piece of two strokes.

The first stroke. It runs right, turns down, and at the foot hooks back to the left.

The second stroke. A long stroke falling to the left, from above the first stroke, down through it to the bottom left.

1 + 1 = two.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 力, all two, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 力 have? (**Two**.) Where have you written it before? (**At the foot of 男**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 力, pinned stroke paths and medians.

474.4 体力 (tǐlì) — stamina; physical fitness

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the arm, then the Mandarin for physical strength.

You'll want to know: 体力

体力 — *tǐlì* — "stamina; physical fitness".

他病了一个月脸色和体力都不好 *tā bìng le yí ge yuè liǎnsè hé tǐlì dōu bù hǎo* — He was ill for a month, and his colour and stamina are both poor.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

体力 (*tǐlì*) is built from 体 'body' and 力 'strength', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *lik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the body' and the second 'sinew'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐlì*
- *Say it: tǐlì*, once more
- *Say it: tā bìng le yí ge yuè liǎnsè hé tǐlì dōu bù hǎo* — He was ill for a month, and his colour and stamina are both poor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the arm, then the Mandarin for physical strength, then say *tǐlì* again

Before you move on

What does 体力 mean? ("Stamina; physical fitness".) Say it once more.

474.5 用力 (yònglì) — to push hard; to put one's strength into it

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for physical strength, then the Mandarin for stamina.

You'll want to know: 用力

用力 — *yònglì* — "to push hard; to put one's strength into it".

> 牙医说吃东西的时候不要太用力 *yáyī shuō chī dōngxi de shíhou bú yào tài yònglì* — The dentist says not to bite down too hard when I eat.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

用力 (*yònglì*) is built from 用 'to use' and 力 'strength', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yowngH* and *lik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yònglì*
- *Say it: yònglì*, once more
- *Say it: yáyī shuō chī dōngxi de shíhou bú yào tài yònglì* — The dentist says not to bite down too hard when I eat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for physical strength, then the Mandarin for stamina, then say *yònglì* again

Before you move on

What does 用力 mean? ("To push hard; to put one's strength into it".) Say it once more.

474.6 shǒuzhǐ — finger

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for stamina, then the Mandarin for to put one's strength into it.

You'll want to know: shǒuzhǐ

shǒuzhǐ — "finger".

wǒ gǎnjué shǒuzhǐ hěn lěng — My fingers feel really cold.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: shǒu is said with a rising tone before zhǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǒuzhǐ is built from 手 'hand' and *zhǐ* 'finger', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *tsyijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second with this very word.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒuzhǐ*
- *Say it: shǒuzhǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué shǒuzhǐ hěn lěng* — My fingers feel really cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for stamina, then the Mandarin for to put one's strength into it, then say *shǒuzhǐ* again

Before you move on

What does shǒuzhǐ mean? (“Finger”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 475

Head to Knees

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the palm of my hand, my knees and back, how tall I am, and bending an arm.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 475: I can talk about the palm of my hand, my knees and back, how tall I am, and bending an arm.*

475.1 手心 (shǒuxīn) — the palm of the hand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put one's strength into it, then the Mandarin for a finger.

You'll want to know: 手心

手心 — *shǒuxīn* — "the palm of the hand".

> 我手心很热是不是体温高了 *wǒ shǒuxīn hěn rè shì bu shì tǐwēn gāo le* — My palms are hot. Is my temperature up?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

手心 (*shǒuxīn*) is built from 手 'hand' and 心 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuwX* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the heart, or middle, of the hand.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǒuxīn*
- *Say it: shǒuxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shǒuxīn hěn rè shì bu shì tǐwēn gāo le* — My palms are hot. Is my temperature up?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put one's strength into it, then the Mandarin for a finger, then say *shǒuxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 手心 mean? ("The palm of the hand".) Say it once more.

475.2 xīgài — knee

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a finger, then the Mandarin for the palm of the hand.

You'll want to know: xīgài

xīgài — "knee".

wǒ zǒu le yì tiān lù xīgài hěn téng — I walked all day, and my knees really hurt.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīgài is built from *xī* 'the knee' and *gài* 'a cover', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sit* and *kajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as the joint of the leg and glosses the second 'to cover'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīgài*
- *Say it: xīgài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zǒu le yì tiān lù xīgài hěn téng* — I walked all day, and my knees really hurt.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a finger, then the Mandarin for the palm of the hand, then say *xīgài* again

Before you move on

What does xīgài mean? ("Knee".) Say it once more.

475.3 hòubèi — the back of the body

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the palm of the hand, then the Mandarin for the knee.

You'll want to know: hòubèi

hòubèi — "the back of the body".

wǒ gǎnjué hòubèi yǒudiǎnr téng — My back feels a bit sore.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hòubèi is built from 后 'behind' and *bèi* 'the back', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *pwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the spine and back'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòubèi*
- *Say it: hòubèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué hòubèi yǒudiǎnr téng* — My back feels a bit sore.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the palm of the hand, then the Mandarin for the knee, then say *hòubèi* again

Before you move on

What does hòubèi mean? ("The back of the body".) Say it once more.

475.4 身高 (shēngāo) — a person's height; body height

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the knee, then the Mandarin for the back of the body.

You'll want to know: 身高

身高 — *shēngāo* — "a person's height; body height".

你身高多少 *nǐ shēngāo duōshao* — How tall are you?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

身高 (*shēngāo*) is built from 身 'body' and 高 'high', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syin* and *kaw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'oneself' and the second 'high'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngāo*
- *Say it: shēngāo*, once more

- *Say it: nǐ shēngāo duōshao* — How tall are you?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the knee, then the Mandarin for the back of the body, then say *shēngāo* again

Before you move on

What does 身高 mean? ("A person's height; body height".) Say it once more.

475.5 wān — to bend

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the back of the body, then the Mandarin for a person's height.

You'll want to know: wān

wān — "to bend".

wǒ de gēbo bù néng wān — I can't bend my arm.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wān is inherited from Middle Chinese *'waen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), explained after an older book as drawing a bow with the arrow set: the bow bends.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wān*
- *Say it: wān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de gēbo bù néng wān* — I can't bend my arm.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the back of the body, then the Mandarin for a person's height, then say *wān* again

Before you move on

What does wān mean? ("To bend".) Say it once more.

475.6 Looking back: from Faults to Head to Knees

Say the Mandarin for selfish and stubborn.

Your turn

- *Say it:* selfish, stubborn, full of oneself, slapdash, slow-witted
- *Say it:* tears, right before one's eyes, petty and narrow-minded, short-sighted, to wink
- *Say it:* an eyebrow, the colour of one's face, to turn hostile suddenly, the look on one's face, the forehead
- *Say it:* the mouth, a dentist, the teeth, to have a tooth pulled, to have a tooth filled
- *Say it:* the arm, physical strength, stamina, to put one's strength into it, a finger
- *Say it:* the palm of the hand, the knee, the back of the body, a person's height, to bend
- *Read it:* 眼 脸 牙 力 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Selfish? (*zìsī.*) Stubborn? (*gùzhí.*) Full of oneself? (*jiāo'ào.*) Slapdash? (*mǎhu.*) Slow-witted? (*bèn.*) Tears? (*yǎnlèi.*) Right before one's eyes? (眼前, *yǎnqián.*) Petty and narrow-minded? (小心眼, *xiǎoxīnyǎn.*) Short-sighted? (*jìnshì.*) To wink? (*zhǎyǎn.*) An eyebrow? (*méimao.*) The colour of one's face? (脸色, *liǎnsè.*) To turn hostile suddenly? (变脸, *biànliǎn.*) The look on one's face? (*biǎoqíng.*) The forehead? (*étóu.*) The mouth? (*zuǐ.*) A dentist? (牙医, *yáyī.*) The teeth? (*yáchǐ.*) To have a tooth pulled? (*báyá.*) To have a tooth filled? (*bǔyá.*) The arm? (*gēbo.*) Physical strength?

(力气, *lìqi.*) Stamina? (体力, *tǐlì.*) To put one's strength into it? (用力, *yònglì.*) A finger? (*shǒuzhǐ.*) The palm of the hand? (手心, *shǒuxīn.*) The knee? (*xīgài.*) The back of the body? (*hòubèi.*) A person's height? (身高, *shēngāo.*) To bend? (*wān.*)

Chapter 476

Neck and Shoulders

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my neck, tongue and shoulders, shaking my head, and pain getting better.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 476: I can talk about my neck, tongue and shoulders, shaking my head, and pain getting better.*

476.1 bózi — neck

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a person's height, then the Mandarin for to bend.

You'll want to know: bózi

bózi — "neck".

> *wǒ kàn le sān ge xiǎoshí diànnǎo bózi hěn téng* — I spent three hours at the computer, and my neck really hurts.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bózi is built from *bó* and 子, a noun ending, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bwot* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the navel; how it came to mean the neck is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bózi*
- *Say it: bózi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ kàn le sān ge xiǎoshí diànnǎo bózi hěn téng* — I spent three hours at the computer, and my neck really hurts.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a person's height, then the Mandarin for to bend, then say *bózi* again

Before you move on

What does bózi mean? ("Neck".) Say it once more.

476.2 shétou — tongue

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to bend, then the Mandarin for the neck.

You'll want to know: shétou

shétou — "tongue".

wǒ de shétou téng le liǎng tiān — My tongue has been sore for two days.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shétou is built from *shé* 'the tongue' and 头, a noun ending here, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zyet* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under two readings and glosses *zyet* as the tongue in the mouth; the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shétou*
- *Say it: shétou*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shétou téng le liǎng tiān* — My tongue has been sore for two days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to bend, then the Mandarin for the neck, then say *shétou* again

Before you move on

What does shétou mean? ("Tongue".) Say it once more.

476.3 jiānbǎng — shoulder

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the neck, then the Mandarin for the tongue.

You'll want to know: jiānbǎng

jiānbǎng — "shoulder".

wǒ de jiānbǎng hěn téng bù néng ná dōngxi — My shoulder hurts so much I can't carry anything.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiānbǎng is built from *jiān* 'the shoulder' and *bǎng*. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *ken* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as the part below the nape. The dictionary lists the second only as *bang*, in the word for the bladder, so the reading *bǎng* and the sense 'shoulder' are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiānbǎng*
- *Say it: jiānbǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de jiānbǎng hěn téng bù néng ná dōngxi* — My shoulder hurts so much I can't carry anything.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the neck, then the Mandarin for the tongue, then say *jiānbǎng* again

Before you move on

What does jiānbǎng mean? ("Shoulder".) Say it once more.

476.4 yáotóu — to shake one's head

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the tongue, then the Mandarin for the shoulder.

You'll want to know: yáotóu

yáotóu — "to shake one's head".

wǒ wèn tā qù bu qù tā yáotóu — I asked him whether he was going, and he shook his head.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yáotóu is built from *yáo* 'to shake' and 头 'head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yew* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yáotóu*
- *Say it: yáotóu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wèn tā qù bu qù tā yáotóu* — I asked him whether he was going, and he shook his head.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the tongue, then the Mandarin for the shoulder, then say *yáotóu* again

Before you move on

What does yáotóu mean? ("To shake one's head".) Say it once more.

476.5 téngtòng — pain; ache

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the shoulder, then the Mandarin for to shake one's head.

You'll want to know: téngtòng

téngtòng — "pain; ache".

chī yào yǐhòu téngtòng hǎo le yìdiǎnr — After taking the medicine, the pain eased a little.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

téngtòng is built from 疼 'pain' and *tòng* 'to hurt', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *downg* and *thuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'pain' and the second 'illness' and 'to hurt'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: téngtòng*
- *Say it: téngtòng*, once more
- *Say it: chī yào yǐhòu téngtòng hǎo le yìdiǎnr* — After taking the medicine, the pain eased a little.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the shoulder, then the Mandarin for to shake one's head, then say *téngtòng* again

Before you move on

What does téngtòng mean? ("Pain; ache".) Say it once more.

Chapter 477

Inside the Body

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the heart, bones and the brain, my stomach and my appetite.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 477: I can talk about the heart, bones and the brain, my stomach and my appetite.*

477.1 xīnzàng — the heart as an organ

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shake one's head, then the Mandarin for bodily pain.

You'll want to know: xīnzàng

xīnzàng — "the heart as an organ".

> *wǒ yéye de xīnzàng bú tài hǎo* — My grandfather has a weak heart.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnzàng is built from 心 'heart' and *zàng* 'an inner organ'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as the organ of fire; no dictionary we use records an older form of the second under this spelling, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnzàng*
- *Say it: xīnzàng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yéye de xīnzàng bú tài hǎo* — My grandfather has a weak heart.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shake one's head, then the Mandarin for bodily pain, then say *xīnzàng* again

Before you move on

What does xīnzàng mean? ("The heart as an organ".) Say it once more.

477.2 gǔtou — bone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bodily pain, then the Mandarin for the heart as an organ.

You'll want to know: gǔtou

gǔtou — "bone".

gǒu zuì xǐhuan chī gǔtou — Dogs love chewing bones more than anything.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǔtou is built from *gǔ* 'bone' and 头, a noun ending here, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwot* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as the core of the flesh; the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔtou*
- *Say it: gǔtou*, once more
- *Say it: gǒu zuì xǐhuan chī gǔtou* — Dogs love chewing bones more than anything.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bodily pain, then the Mandarin for the heart as an organ, then say *gǔtou* again

Before you move on

What does gǔtou mean? ("Bone".) Say it once more.

477.3 dànǎo — brain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the heart as an organ, then the Mandarin for a bone.

You'll want to know: dànǎo

dànǎo — "brain".

shuìjiào de shíhou dànǎo yě zài gōngzuò — Even while you sleep, your brain is working.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dànǎo is built from 大 'big' and *nǎo* 'the brain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dajH* and *nawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the brain in the head.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dànǎo*
- *Say it: dànǎo*, once more
- *Say it: shuìjiào de shíhou dànǎo yě zài gōngzuò* — Even while you sleep, your brain is working.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the heart as an organ, then the Mandarin for a bone, then say *dànǎo* again

Before you move on

What does dànǎo mean? ("Brain".) Say it once more.

477.4 chángwèi — stomach and gut; digestion

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a bone, then the Mandarin for the brain.

You'll want to know: chángwèi

chángwèi — "stomach and gut; digestion".

wǒ chángwèi bù shūfu le liǎng tiān — My stomach has been upset for two days.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chángwèi is built from *cháng* 'the gut' and *wèi* 'the stomach', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjang* and *hjw+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first in this very pair and the second, after an older book, as the storehouse of grain.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chángwèi*
- *Say it: chángwèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chángwèi bù shūfu le liǎng tiān* — My stomach has been upset for two days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a bone, then the Mandarin for the brain, then say *chángwèi* again

Before you move on

What does chángwèi mean? ("Stomach and gut; digestion".) Say it once more.

477.5 wèikǒu — appetite

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the brain, then the Mandarin for one's digestion.

You'll want to know: wèikǒu

wèikǒu — "appetite".

wǒ bìng le sān tiān wèikǒu bù hǎo — I've been ill for three days and have no appetite.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wèikǒu is built from *wèi* 'the stomach' and 口 'mouth', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjw+jH* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary explains the first, after an older book, as the storehouse of grain.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wèikǒu*
- *Say it: wèikǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bìng le sān tiān wèikǒu bù hǎo* — I've been ill for three days and have no appetite.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the brain, then the Mandarin for one's digestion, then say *wèikǒu* again

Before you move on

What does wèikǒu mean? ("Appetite".) Say it once more.

Chapter 478

Injuries

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I burned myself, talk about a wound and serious injuries, a sprain and having a wound dressed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 478: I can say I burned myself, talk about a wound and serious injuries, a sprain and having a wound dressed.*

478.1 tàngshāng — to scald; to burn (with heat)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's digestion, then the Mandarin for an appetite.

You'll want to know: tàngshāng

tàngshāng — "to scald; to burn (with heat)".

> *wǒ zuò fàn de shíhou tàngshāng le shǒu* — I burned my hand while I was cooking.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tàngshāng is built from *tàng* 'scalding hot' and *shāng* 'to hurt'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *syang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to harm'; no dictionary we use records an older form of the first under this spelling, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tàngshāng*
- *Say it: tàngshāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuò fàn de shíhou tàngshāng le shǒu* — I burned my hand while I was cooking.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's digestion, then the Mandarin for an appetite, then say *tàngshāng* again

Before you move on

What does tàngshāng mean? ("To scald; to burn (with heat)".) Say it once more.

478.2 伤口 (shāngkǒu) — wound; cut

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an appetite, then the Mandarin for to scald oneself.

You'll want to know: 伤口

伤口 — *shāngkǒu* — "wound; cut".

> 我感觉伤口很疼体温也高了 *wǒ gǎnjué shāngkǒu hěn téng tǐwēn yě gāo le* — My wound really hurts, and my temperature has gone up too.

The new character, in pieces: 伤 — six strokes in three pieces: on the left 亻, two strokes; at the top right a short stroke falling to the left and a bar; and under them 力 *lì*, two strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

伤口 (*shāngkǒu*) is built from 伤 'to hurt' and 口 'an opening', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syang* and *khuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to harm' and the second 'the mouth'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāngkǒu*
- *Say it: shāngkǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué shāngkǒu hěn téng tǐwēn yě gāo le* — My wound really hurts, and my temperature has gone up too.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an appetite, then the Mandarin for to scald oneself, then say *shāngkǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 伤口 mean? ("Wound; cut".) Say it once more.

478.3 伤 — 亻, then a short top over 力

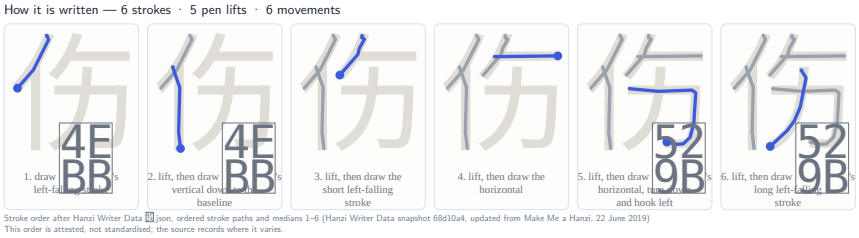
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shāngkǒu* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

力 你

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lì*, *nǐ*

Script — 亻, then a short top over 力



How 伤 is written, stroke by stroke

伤

Three pieces: the left, then the top right, then the bottom right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, 亻, two strokes. A stroke falling to the left, then a vertical down.

The top right, two strokes. A short stroke falling to the left, then a bar from left to right beside it.

The bottom right, 力, two strokes. A stroke that runs right, turns down and hooks to the left, then a long stroke falling to the left through it.

2 + 2 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 伤, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 伤 have? (**Three, two strokes each.**)
Which written character ends it? (力.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 伤, pinned stroke paths and medians.

478.4 重伤 (zhòngshāng) — serious injury; badly hurt

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to scald oneself, then the Mandarin for an open wound.

You'll want to know: 重伤

重伤 — *zhòngshāng* — "serious injury; badly hurt".

那个事故里有两个人重伤 *nàge shìgù lǐ yǒu liǎng ge rén zhòngshāng* — Two people were badly hurt in that accident.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

重伤 (*zhòngshāng*) is built from 重 'heavy' and 伤 'to hurt', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjowngX* and *syang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'thick' and the second 'to harm'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòngshāng*
- *Say it: zhòngshāng*, once more
- *Say it: nàge shìgù lǐ yǒu liǎng ge rén zhòngshāng* — Two people were badly hurt in that accident.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to scald oneself, then the Mandarin for an open wound, then say *zhòngshāng* again

Before you move on

What does 重伤 mean? ("Serious injury; badly hurt".) Say it once more.

478.5 niǔshāng — to sprain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an open wound, then the Mandarin for badly hurt.

You'll want to know: niǔshāng

niǔshāng — "to sprain".

wǒ niǔshāng guo jiǎo — I've sprained my ankle before.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

niǔshāng is built from *niǔ* 'to twist' and 伤 'to hurt', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nrjuwX* and *syang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under two readings and glosses *nrjuwX* as a hand turning.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: niǔshāng*
- *Say it: niǔshāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ niǔshāng guo jiǎo* — I've sprained my ankle before.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an open wound, then the Mandarin for badly hurt, then say *niǔshāng* again

Before you move on

What does niǔshāng mean? ("To sprain".) Say it once more.

478.6 bāozā — to bandage; to dress a wound

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for badly hurt, then the Mandarin for to sprain.

You'll want to know: bāozā

bāozā — "to bandage; to dress a wound".

> *hùshi gěi wǒ bāozā le shāngkǒu* — The nurse dressed my wound.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bāozā is built from 包 'to wrap' and *zā* 'to bind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *paew* and *tsreat* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to wrap' and the second, in its fuller spelling, as binding the grip of a bow. The regular sound change would give *zhá*; why it is said *zā* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāozā*
- *Say it: bāozā*, once more
- *Say it: hùshi gěi wǒ bāozā le shāngkǒu* — The nurse dressed my wound.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for badly hurt, then the Mandarin for to sprain, then say *bāozā* again

Before you move on

What does bāozā mean? ("To bandage; to dress a wound".) Say it once more.

Chapter 479

Blood

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a scar, blood, stopping the bleeding, giving blood and blood pressure.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 479: I can talk about a scar, blood, stopping the bleeding, giving blood and blood pressure.*

479.1 shāngbā — scar

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sprain, then the Mandarin for to dress a wound.

You'll want to know: shāngbā

shāngbā — "scar".

> *zhège shāngbā yǐjīng yǒu shí nián le* — I've had this scar for ten years now.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shāngbā is built from 伤 'to hurt' and *bā* 'a scar'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *syang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to harm'; no dictionary we use records an older form of the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shāngbā*
- *Say it: shāngbā*, once more
- *Say it: zhège shāngbā yǐjīng yǒu shí nián le* — I've had this scar for ten years now.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sprain, then the Mandarin for to dress a wound, then say *shāngbā* again

Before you move on

What does shāngbā mean? ("Scar".) Say it once more.

479.2 血 (xiě) — blood

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dress a wound, then the Mandarin for a scar.

You'll want to know: 血

血 — *xiě* — "blood".

你看这是血 *nǐ kàn zhè shì xiě* — Look, that's blood.

The new character, in pieces: 血 — six strokes: a short stroke falling to the left at the top, then a dish of five, as at the foot of 温 *wēn*. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

Alone, and in everyday speech, 血 is said xiě; in words such as liúxuè it is said xuè.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

血 (*xiě*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *xwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), explained after an older book as what flows out of the flesh. The regular sound change gives *xuè*; the everyday *xiě* is a

second, spoken reading, and how it arose is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiě*
- *Say it: xiě*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ kàn zhè shì xiě* — Look, that's blood.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dress a wound, then the Mandarin for a scar, then say *xiě* again

Before you move on

What does 血 mean? ("Blood".) Say it once more.

479.3 血 — one short stroke over a dish

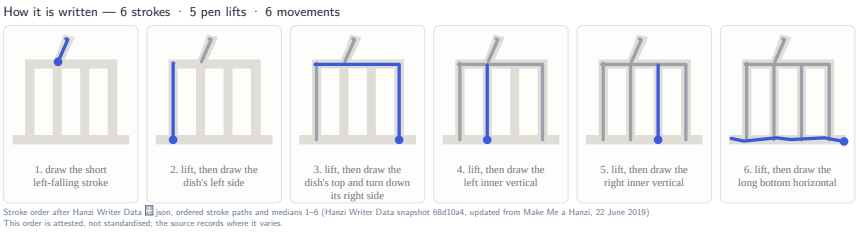
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xiě* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  温 白

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wēn*, *bái*

Script — one short stroke over a dish



How 血 is written, stroke by stroke

血

Two pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top, one stroke. A short stroke falling to the left, above the middle.

The dish, five strokes, as at the foot of 温. A short vertical on the left, a stroke that runs right and turns down, two short verticals inside, then the long bar across the bottom.

1 + 5 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 血, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 血 have? (**Two: one stroke and five.**)
Where have you written the dish before? (**At the foot of 温.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 血, pinned stroke paths and medians.

479.4 zhǐxuè — to stop the bleeding

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a scar, then the Mandarin for blood.

You'll want to know: zhǐxuè

zhǐxuè — "to stop the bleeding".

yīshēng yòng le shí fēnzhōng cái zhǐxuè — It took the doctor ten minutes to stop the bleeding.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǐxuè is built from *zhǐ* 'to stop' and 血 'blood', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyiX* and *xwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription),

which glosses the first 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǐxuè*
- *Say it: zhǐxuè*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng yòng le shí fēnzhōng cái zhǐxuè* — It took the doctor ten minutes to stop the bleeding.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a scar, then the Mandarin for blood, then say *zhǐxuè* again

Before you move on

What does zhǐxuè mean? ("To stop the bleeding".) Say it once more.

479.5 xiànxuè — to give blood

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for blood, then the Mandarin for to stop the bleeding.

You'll want to know: xiànxuè

xiànxuè — "to give blood".

wǒ měi nián dōu qù xiànxuè — I give blood every year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiànxuè is built from *xiàn* 'to offer' and 血 'blood', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjonH* and *xwet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under two readings and glosses *xjonH* 'to present'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiànxuè*
- *Say it: xiànxuè*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ měi nián dōu qù xiànxuè* — I give blood every year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for blood, then the Mandarin for to stop the bleeding, then say *xiànxuè* again

Before you move on

What does xiànxuè mean? ("To give blood".) Say it once more.

479.6 xuèyā — blood pressure

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stop the bleeding, then the Mandarin for to give blood.

You'll want to know: xuèyā

xuèyā — "blood pressure".

wǒ bàba de xuèyā bǐ wǒ gāo — My dad's blood pressure is higher than mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuèyā is built from 血 'blood' and *yā* 'to press', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xwet* and *'aep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to press down'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuèyā*
- *Say it: xuèyā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba de xuèyā bǐ wǒ gāo* — My dad's blood pressure is higher than mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stop the bleeding, then the Mandarin for to give blood, then say *xuèyā* again

Before you move on

What does xuèyā mean? ("Blood pressure".) Say it once more.

Chapter 480

Symptoms

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I feel dizzy or itchy, that my nose is running, that I am allergic to something, and that I cannot sleep.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 480: I can say I feel dizzy or itchy, that my nose is running, that I am allergic to something, and that I cannot sleep.*

480.1 tóuyūn — dizzy

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give blood, then the Mandarin for blood pressure.

You'll want to know: tóuyūn

tóuyūn — "dizzy".

> *wǒ gǎnjué yǒudiǎnr tóuyūn* — I feel a bit dizzy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóuyūn is built from 头 'head' and *yūn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duw* and *hjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a halo round the sun or moon. The level tone of *yūn* is irregular, and the sense 'dizzy' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóuyūn*
- *Say it: tóuyūn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué yǒudiǎnr tóuyūn* — I feel a bit dizzy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give blood, then the Mandarin for blood pressure, then say *tóuyūn* again

Before you move on

What does tóuyūn mean? ("Dizzy".) Say it once more.

480.2 fāyǎng — to itch

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for blood pressure, then the Mandarin for dizzy.

You'll want to know: fāyǎng

fāyǎng — "to itch".

shāngkǒu yǒudiǎnr fāyǎng — The wound is a bit itchy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fāyǎng is built from 发 'to set going' and *yǎng* 'itchy', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *yangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as itchy skin.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāyǎng*
- *Say it: fāyǎng*, once more
- *Say it: shāngkǒu yǒudiǎnr fāyǎng* — The wound is a bit itchy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for blood pressure, then the Mandarin for dizzy, then say *fāyǎng* again

Before you move on

What does fāyǎng mean? ("To itch".) Say it once more.

480.3 liú bítì — to have a runny nose

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for dizzy, then the Mandarin for to itch.

You'll want to know: liú bítì

liú bítì — "to have a runny nose".

wǒ gǎnmào le liǎng tiān xiànzài hái zài liú bítì — I've had a cold for two days, and my nose is still running.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liú bítì is built from *liú* 'to flow', *bí* 'nose' and *tì*, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw*, *bjijH* and *thejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the first, after an older book, as water moving, and glosses the third as tears; the sense 'mucus of the nose' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: liú bítì*
- *Say it: liú bítì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnmào le liǎng tiān xiànzài hái zài liú bítì* — I've had a cold for two days, and my nose is still running.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for dizzy, then the Mandarin for to itch, then say *liú bítì* again

Before you move on

What does liú bítì mean? ("To have a runny nose".) Say it once more.

480.4 guòmǐn — to be allergic

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to itch, then the Mandarin for to have a runny nose.

You'll want to know: guòmǐn

guòmǐn — "to be allergic".

wǒ duì huā guòmǐn — I'm allergic to flowers.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guòmǐn is built from 过 'beyond' and *mǐn* 'quick', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaH* and *minX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go beyond' and the second 'quick' and 'clever': too quick to react. The medical sense is modern.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: guòmǐn*
- *Say it: guòmǐn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ duì huā guòmǐn* — I'm allergic to flowers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to itch, then the Mandarin for to have a runny nose, then say *guòmǐn* again

Before you move on

What does guòmǐn mean? ("To be allergic".) Say it once more.

480.5 shīmián — to be unable to sleep; to lie awake at night

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to have a runny nose, then the Mandarin for to be allergic.

You'll want to know: shīmián

shīmián — "to be unable to sleep; to lie awake at night".

wǒ shīmián le yí ge xīngqī — I haven't been able to sleep for a week.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīmián is built from *shī* 'to lose' and *mián* 'sleep', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *men* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to let slip' and the second 'to sleep'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīmián*
- *Say it: shīmián*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shīmián le yí ge xīngqī* — I haven't been able to sleep for a week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to have a runny nose, then the Mandarin for to be allergic, then say *shīmián* again

Before you move on

What does shīmián mean? ("To be unable to sleep; to lie awake at night".) Say it once more.

480.6 Looking back: from Neck and Shoulders to Symptoms

Say the Mandarin for the neck and the tongue.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the neck, the tongue, the shoulder, to shake one's head, bodily pain
- *Say it:* the heart as an organ, a bone, the brain, one's digestion, an appetite
- *Say it:* to scald oneself, an open wound, badly hurt, to sprain, to dress a wound
- *Say it:* a scar, blood, to stop the bleeding, to give blood, blood pressure
- *Say it:* dizzy, to itch, to have a runny nose, to be allergic, to lie awake at night
- *Read it:* 伤 血 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The neck? (*bózi.*) The tongue? (*shétou.*) The shoulder? (*jiānbǎng.*) To shake one's head? (*yáotóu.*) Bodily pain? (*téngtòng.*) The heart as an organ? (*xīnzàng.*) A bone? (*gǔtou.*) The brain? (*dànǎo.*) One's digestion? (*chángwèi.*) An appetite? (*wèikǒu.*) To scald oneself? (*tàngshāng.*) An open wound? (伤口, *shāngkǒu.*) Badly hurt? (重伤, *zhòngshāng.*) To sprain? (*niǔshāng.*) To dress a wound? (*bāozā.*) A scar? (*shāngbā.*) Blood? (血, *xiě.*) To stop the bleeding? (*zhǐxuè.*) To give blood? (*xiànxuè.*) Blood pressure? (*xuèyā.*) Dizzy? (*tóuyūn.*) To itch? (*fāyǎng.*) To have a runny nose? (*liú bítì.*) To be allergic? (*guòmǐn.*) To lie awake at night? (*shīmián.*)

Chapter 481

Is It Serious?

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask whether it is serious, talk about a patient's condition, the cause of an illness, infection and viruses.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 481: I can ask whether it is serious, talk about a patient's condition, the cause of an illness, infection and viruses.*

481.1 要紧 (yàojǐn) — urgent; a cause for concern

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be allergic, then the Mandarin for to lie awake at night.

You'll want to know: 要紧

要紧 — *yàojǐn* — "urgent; a cause for concern".

> **有一点儿血不要紧** *yǒu yìdiǎnr xiě bú yàojǐn* — There's a little blood, but it's nothing serious.

The new character, in pieces: **紧** — ten strokes in three pieces: at the top two short verticals and 又 *yòu*; under them two short zigzag strokes and a dot; and at the foot 小 *xiǎo*, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

要紧 (*yàojǐn*) is built from 要 'to need' and 紧 'tight', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jiewH* and *kjinX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to bind' and the second 'tightly bound'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàojǐn*
- *Say it: yàojǐn*, once more
- *Say it: yǒu yìdiǎnr xiě bú yàojǐn* — There's a little blood, but it's nothing serious.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be allergic, then the Mandarin for to lie awake at night, then say *yàojǐn* again

Before you move on

What does 要紧 mean? ("Urgent; a cause for concern".) Say it once more.

481.2 紧 — two verticals and 又, over a silk piece ending in 小

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yàojǐn* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  又 小 要

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yòu*, *xiǎo*, *yào*

Script — two verticals and 又, over a silk piece ending in 小

How 紧 *is written, stroke by stroke*

紧

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top, four strokes. Two short verticals side by side, then 又: a bar that turns into a stroke falling to the left, and a long stroke falling to the right.

The middle, three strokes. A short stroke down that turns right, a second one like it to its lower right, then a dot.

The foot, 小, three strokes. A vertical that hooks to the left, a dot on the left, then a dot on the right.

4 + 3 + 3 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 紧, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 紧 have? (**Three: four strokes, three and three.**) Which written characters are inside it? (**又 at the top**

and 小 at the foot.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 紧, pinned stroke paths and medians.

481.3 病情 (bìngqíng) — a patient's condition; how an illness is going

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lie awake at night, then the Mandarin for serious or urgent.

You'll want to know: 病情

病情 — *bìngqíng* — "a patient's condition; how an illness is going".

他的病情不要紧你不要伤心 *tā de bìngqíng bú yàojǐn nǐ bú yào shāngxīn* — His condition isn't serious, so don't be upset.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

病情 (*bìngqíng*) is built from 病 'illness' and 情 'the state of things', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaengH* and *dzjeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as an illness growing worse.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìngqíng*
- *Say it: bìngqíng*, once more
- *Say it: tā de bìngqíng bú yàojǐn nǐ bú yào shāngxīn* — His condition isn't serious, so don't be upset.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lie awake at night, then the Mandarin for serious or urgent, then say *bìngqíng* again

Before you move on

What does 病情 mean? ("A patient's condition; how an illness is going".) Say it once more.

481.4 病因 (bìngyīn) — cause of an illness

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for serious or urgent, then the Mandarin for how an illness is going.

You'll want to know: 病因

病因 — *bìngyīn* — "cause of an illness".

> 牙医看了半天还没找到病因 *yáyī kàn le bàntiān hái méi zhǎo dào bìngyīn* — The dentist has been looking for ages and still hasn't found the cause.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

病因 (*bìngyīn*) is built from 病 'illness' and 因 'a cause', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaengH* and *'jin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to rely on' and 'a cause'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìngyīn*
- *Say it: bìngyīn*, once more
- *Say it: yáyī kàn le bàntiān hái méi zhǎo dào bìngyīn* — The dentist has been looking for ages and still hasn't found the cause.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for serious or urgent, then the Mandarin for how an illness is going, then say *bìngyīn* again

Before you move on

What does 病因 mean? ("Cause of an illness".) Say it once more.

481.5 gǎnrǎn — to become infected

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how an illness is going, then the Mandarin for the cause of an illness.

You'll want to know: gǎnrǎn

gǎnrǎn — "to become infected".

wǒ gǎnjué shāngkǒu gǎnrǎn le — I think the wound has become infected.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: gǎn is said with a rising tone before rǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎnrǎn is built from 感 'to move' and *rǎn* 'to dye', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *komX* and *nyemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move' and the second 'to dye'. The medical sense is modern.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎnrǎn*
- *Say it: gǎnrǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gǎnjué shāngkǒu gǎnrǎn le* — I think the wound has become infected.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how an illness is going, then the Mandarin for the cause of an illness, then say *gǎnrǎn* again

Before you move on

What does gǎnrǎn mean? (“To become infected”.) Say it once more.

481.6 bìngdú — virus

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the cause of an illness, then the Mandarin for to become infected.

You’ll want to know: bìngdú

bìngdú — “virus”.

zhège bìngdú bǐ gǎnmào kěpà — This virus is worse than a cold.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bìngdú is built from 病 ’illness’ and *dú* ’poison’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjaengH* and *dowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the second ’harm’ and, after an older book, as a plant that harms people. The sense ’virus’ is modern.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìngdú*
- *Say it: bìngdú*, once more
- *Say it: zhège bìngdú bǐ gǎnmào kěpà* — This virus is worse than a cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the cause of an illness, then the Mandarin for to become infected, then say *bìngdú* again

Before you move on

What does bìngdú mean? (“Virus”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 482

Treatment

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the emergency department, treatment, tablets, cleaning a wound and nursing the sick.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 482: I can talk about the emergency department, treatment, tablets, cleaning a wound and nursing the sick.*

482.1 jízhěn — emergency department; urgent treatment

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to become infected, then the Mandarin for a virus.

You'll want to know: jízhěn

jízhěn — "emergency department; urgent treatment".

> *wǒ xiǎng dāng jízhěn yīshēng* — I want to be an emergency doctor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jízhěn is built from *jí* 'urgent' and *zhěn* 'to examine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kip* and *tsyinX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'urgent' and the second as feeling the pulse.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jízhěn*
- *Say it: jízhěn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng dāng jízhěn yīshēng* — I want to be an emergency doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to become infected, then the Mandarin for a virus, then say *jízhěn* again

Before you move on

What does jízhěn mean? ("Emergency department; urgent treatment".) Say it once more.

482.2 zhìliáo — to give medical treatment; to cure

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a virus, then the Mandarin for the emergency department.

You'll want to know: zhìliáo

zhìliáo — "to give medical treatment; to cure".

tā zhìliáo le bàn nián xiànzài yǐjīng hǎo le — He was treated for six months, and now he's well again.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhìliáo is built from *zhì* 'to put in order' and *liáo* 'to heal', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dri* and *ljewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under three readings and glosses them 'to put in order'; it glosses the second 'to treat an illness'. The falling tone of *zhì* follows the reading *driH*.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhìliáo*
- *Say it: zhìliáo*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhìliáo le bàn nián xiànzài yǐjīng hǎo le* — He was treated for six months, and now he's well again.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a virus, then the Mandarin for the emergency department, then say *zhìliáo* again

Before you move on

What does zhìliáo mean? ("To give medical treatment; to cure".) Say it once more.

482.3 yàopiàn — tablet; pill

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the emergency department, then the Mandarin for to give medical treatment.

You'll want to know: yàopiàn

yàopiàn — "tablet; pill".

yīshēng shuō yàopiàn yì tiān chī sān cì — The doctor says to take the pills three times a day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yàopiàn is built from *yào* 'medicine' and *piàn* 'a slice', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yak* and *phenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as a plant that cures illness, and glosses the second 'half' and 'a split piece of wood'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàopiàn*
- *Say it: yàopiàn*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng shuō yàopiàn yì tiān chī sān cì* — The doctor says to take the pills three times a day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the emergency department, then the Mandarin for to give medical treatment, then say *yàopiàn* again

Before you move on

What does yàopiàn mean? ("Tablet; pill".) Say it once more.

482.4 xiāodú — to disinfect

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give medical treatment, then the Mandarin for a pill.

You'll want to know: xiāodú

xiāodú — "to disinfect".

hùshi xiān gěi shāngkǒu xiāodú — The nurse disinfects the wound first.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiāodú is built from *xiāo* 'to wipe out' and *dú* 'poison', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjew* and *dowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to destroy' and 'to use up' and the second 'harm'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiāodú*
- *Say it: xiāodú*, once more
- *Say it: hùshi xiān gěi shāngkǒu xiāodú* — The nurse disinfects the wound first.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give medical treatment, then the Mandarin for a pill, then say *xiāodú* again

Before you move on

What does xiāodú mean? ("To disinfect".) Say it once more.

482.5 护理 (hùlǐ) — to care for the sick; to tend

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a pill, then the Mandarin for to disinfect.

You'll want to know: 护理

护理 — *hùlǐ* — "to care for the sick; to tend".

护理病人的时候你不能怕血 *hùlǐ bìngrén de shíhou nǐ bù néng pà xiě* — When you look after patients, you can't be afraid of blood.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

护理 (*hùlǐ*) is built from 护 'to protect' and 理 'to put in order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huH* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rescue' and 'to help' and the second 'to manage'; the sense of caring for the sick is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hùlǐ*
- *Say it: hùlǐ*, once more
- *Say it: hùlǐ bìngrén de shíhou nǐ bù néng pà xiě* — When you look after patients, you can't be afraid of blood.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a pill, then the Mandarin for to disinfect, then say *hùlǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 护理 mean? ("To care for the sick; to tend".) Say it once more.

Chapter 483

Getting Better

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone's illness is improving, that someone has recovered, and talk about nourishing food, keeping well and long illnesses.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 483: I can say someone's illness is improving, that someone has recovered, and talk about nourishing food, keeping well and long illnesses.*

483.1 hǎozhuǎn — to take a turn for the better; to start to improve

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to disinfect, then the Mandarin for to care for the sick.

You'll want to know: hǎozhuǎn

hǎozhuǎn — "to take a turn for the better; to start to improve".

> *tā zhìliáo le yí ge yuè bìngqíng hǎozhuǎn le* — He had treatment for a month, and his illness has taken a turn for the better.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: hǎo is said with a rising tone before zhuǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǎozhuǎn is built from 好 'good' and *zhuǎn* 'to turn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xawX* and *trjwenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to move' and 'to turn round'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǎozhuǎn*
- *Say it: hǎozhuǎn*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhìliáo le yí ge yuè bìngqíng hǎozhuǎn le* — He had treatment for a month, and his illness has taken a turn for the better.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to disinfect, then the Mandarin for to care for the sick, then say *hǎozhuǎn* again

Before you move on

What does hǎozhuǎn mean? ("To take a turn for the better; to start to improve".) Say it once more.

483.2 kāngfù — to get well again; to convalesce

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to care for the sick, then the Mandarin for to start to improve.

You'll want to know: kāngfù

kāngfù — "to get well again; to convalesce".

tā kāngfù le xià ge yuè kěyǐ shàngbān — He has recovered and can go back to work next month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāngfù is built from *kāng* 'at ease' and *fù* 'to return', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khang* and *bjuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'peaceful' and 'happy' and the second 'to return'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāngfù*
- *Say it: kāngfù*, once more
- *Say it: tā kāngfù le xià ge yuè kěyǐ shàngbān* — He has recovered and can go back to work next month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to care for the sick, then the Mandarin for to start to improve, then say *kāngfù* again

Before you move on

What does kāngfù mean? ("To get well again; to convalesce".) Say it once more.

483.3 yíngyǎng — nutrition; nourishment

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to start to improve, then the Mandarin for to get well again.

You'll want to know: yíngyǎng

yíngyǎng — "nutrition; nourishment".

shuǐguǒ hěn yǒu yíngyǎng nǐ yīnggāi měi tiān chī — Fruit is very good for you, so you should eat some every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yíngyǎng is built from *yíng* 'to build' and *yǎng* 'to nourish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yweng* and *yangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to make' and the second 'to raise' and 'to feed'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yíngyǎng*
- *Say it: yíngyǎng*, once more
- *Say it: shuǐguǒ hěn yǒu yíngyǎng nǐ yīnggāi měi tiān chī* — Fruit is very good for you, so you should eat some every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to start to improve, then the Mandarin for to get well again, then say *yíngyǎng* again

Before you move on

What does yíngyǎng mean? ("Nutrition; nourishment".) Say it once more.

483.4 bǎojiàn — health care; looking after one's health

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get well again, then the Mandarin for nourishment.

You'll want to know: bǎojiàn

bǎojiàn — "health care; looking after one's health".

wǒ yéye bǐ wǒ nǎinai zhùyì bǎojiàn — My grandfather takes more care of his health than my grandmother does.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǎojiàn is built from 保 'to keep' and *jiàn* 'strong', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawX* and *gjonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to keep safe' and the second 'strong'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǎojiàn*
- *Say it: bǎojiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yéye bǐ wǒ nǎinai zhùyì bǎojiàn* — My grandfather takes more care of his health than my grandmother does.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get well again, then the Mandarin for nourishment, then say *bǎojiàn* again

Before you move on

What does bǎojiàn mean? ("Health care; looking after one's health".) Say it once more.

483.5 mànxìng — chronic (of an illness)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for nourishment, then the Mandarin for looking after one's health.

You'll want to know: mànxìng

mànxìng — "chronic (of an illness)".

tā yǒu mànxìngbìng yào chángcháng chī yào — He has a chronic illness and has to take medicine regularly.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mànxìng is built from *màn* 'slow' and 性 'nature', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *maenH* and *sjengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'idle' and the second 'nature and conduct'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mànxìng*
- *Say it: mànxìng*, once more
- *Say it: tā yǒu mànxìngbìng yào chángcháng chī yào* — He has a chronic illness and has to take medicine regularly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for nourishment, then the Mandarin for looking after one's health, then say *mànxìng* again

Before you move on

What does mànxìng mean? ("Chronic (of an illness)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 484

Staying Well

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about preventing illness, giving up drinking, forming a habit, feeling worn out and fighting off colds.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 484: I can talk about preventing illness, giving up drinking, forming a habit, feeling worn out and fighting off colds.*

484.1 yùfáng — to prevent; to guard against

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for looking after one's health, then the Mandarin for chronic.

You'll want to know: yùfáng

yùfáng — "to prevent; to guard against".

> *chángcháng xǐ shǒu kěyǐ yùfáng gǎnmào* — Washing your hands often helps prevent colds.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùfáng is built from *yù* 'beforehand' and *fáng* 'to ward off', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yoH* and *bjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'in advance' and the second 'to

guard against’.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùfáng*
- *Say it: yùfáng*, once more
- *Say it: chángcháng xǐ shǒu kěyǐ yùfáng gǎnmào* — Washing your hands often helps prevent colds.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for looking after one’s health, then the Mandarin for chronic, then say *yùfáng* again

Before you move on

What does yùfáng mean? (“To prevent; to guard against”.) Say it once more.

484.2 jièjiǔ — to give up drinking

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for chronic, then the Mandarin for to guard against.

You’ll want to know: jièjiǔ

jièjiǔ — “to give up drinking”.

yīshēng shuō tā yīnggāi jièjiǔ — The doctor says he ought to give up drinking.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jièjiǔ is built from *jiè* ’to guard against’ and 酒 ’alcohol’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keajH* and *tsjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’to be careful’ and ’to be

on guard' and the second as wine.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jièjiǔ*
- *Say it: jièjiǔ*, once more
- *Say it: yīshēng shuō tā yīnggāi jièjiǔ* — The doctor says he ought to give up drinking.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for chronic, then the Mandarin for to guard against, then say *jièjiǔ* again

Before you move on

What does jièjiǔ mean? ("To give up drinking".) Say it once more.

484.3 yǎngchéng — to form (a habit); to get into a habit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to guard against, then the Mandarin for to give up drinking.

You'll want to know: yǎngchéng

yǎngchéng — "to form (a habit); to get into a habit".

> *wǒ yǎngchéng le zǎoshang pǎobù de xíguàn* — I've got into the habit of running in the morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎngchéng is built from *yǎng* 'to raise' and 成 'to complete', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yangX* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rear' and the second 'to finish'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎngchéng*
- *Say it: yǎngchéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǎngchéng le zǎoshang pǎobù de xíguàn* — I've got into the habit of running in the morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to guard against, then the Mandarin for to give up drinking, then say *yǎngchéng* again

Before you move on

What does yǎngchéng mean? ("To form (a habit); to get into a habit".) Say it once more.

484.4 píláo — worn out; fatigued

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give up drinking, then the Mandarin for to get into a habit.

You'll want to know: píláo

píláo — "worn out; fatigued".

wǒ gōngzuò le yì tiān gǎnjué hěn píláo — I've worked all day, and I feel worn out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

píláo is built from *pí* 'weary' and *láo* 'toil', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bje* and *law* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which

glosses the first 'tired' and 'spent' and the second 'tired' and 'hard work'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: píláo*
- *Say it: píláo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gōngzuò le yì tiān gǎnjué hěn píláo* — I've worked all day, and I feel worn out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give up drinking, then the Mandarin for to get into a habit, then say *píláo* again

Before you move on

What does píláo mean? ("Worn out; fatigued".) Say it once more.

484.5 dǐkànglì — resistance to illness

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get into a habit, then the Mandarin for worn out.

You'll want to know: dǐkànglì

dǐkànglì — "resistance to illness".

chángcháng duànliàn de rén dǐkànglì bǐ biérén hǎo — People who exercise regularly fight off illness better than others.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǐkànglì is built from *dǐ* 'to push against', *kàng* 'to resist' and 力 'strength', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *tejX*, *khangH* and *lik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first

'to push' and lists the second under two readings, glossing *khangH* as lifting with the hand.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǐkànglì*
- *Say it: dǐkànglì*, once more
- *Say it: chángcháng duànliàn de rén dǐkànglì bǐ biérén hǎo* — People who exercise regularly fight off illness better than others.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get into a habit, then the Mandarin for worn out, then say *dǐkànglì* again

Before you move on

What does dǐkànglì mean? ("Resistance to illness".) Say it once more.

Chapter 485

Body and Mind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about stress, energy, body and mind, my frame of mind and relieving stress.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 485: I can talk about stress, energy, body and mind, my frame of mind and relieving stress.*

485.1 yālì — pressure; stress

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for worn out, then the Mandarin for resistance to illness.

You'll want to know: yālì

yālì — "pressure; stress".

> *wǒ zuìjìn yālì hěn dà* — I've been under a lot of stress lately.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yālì is built from *yā* 'to press' and 力 'strength', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'aep* and *lik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to press down' and the second 'sinew'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yālì*
- *Say it: yālì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuìjìn yālì hěn dà* — I've been under a lot of stress lately.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for worn out, then the Mandarin for resistance to illness, then say *yālì* again

Before you move on

What does yālì mean? ("Pressure; stress".) Say it once more.

485.2 jīngshen — vigour; get-up-and-go

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for resistance to illness, then the Mandarin for stress and pressure.

You'll want to know: jīngshen

jīngshen — "vigour; get-up-and-go".

hē le kāfēi yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn yǒu jīngshen — After a coffee, I feel full of energy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīngshen is built from *jīng* 'refined' and *shén* 'spirit', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjeng* and *zyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'bright' and 'pure' and the second 'divine'. In this sense the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīngshen*
- *Say it: jīngshen*, once more
- *Say it: hē le kāfēi yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn yǒu jīngshen* — After a coffee, I feel full of energy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for resistance to illness, then the Mandarin for stress and pressure, then say *jīngshen* again

Before you move on

What does jīngshen mean? ("Vigour; get-up-and-go".) Say it once more.

485.3 身心 (shēnxīn) — body and mind

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for stress and pressure, then the Mandarin for get-up-and-go.

You'll want to know: 身心

身心 — *shēnxīn* — "body and mind".

眼前最要紧的是身心都好 *yǎnqián zuì yàojǐn de shì shēnxīn dōu hǎo* — For now, what matters most is being well in body and mind.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

身心 (*shēnxīn*) is built from 身 'body' and 心 'heart', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syin* and *sim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'oneself'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēnxīn*
- *Say it: shēnxīn*, once more
- *Say it: yǎnqián zuì yàojǐn de shì shēnxīn dōu hǎo* — For now, what matters most is being well in body and mind.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for stress and pressure, then the Mandarin for get-up-and-go, then say *shēnxīn* again

Before you move on

What does 身心 mean? ("Body and mind".) Say it once more.

485.4 xīntài — mindset; attitude of mind

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for get-up-and-go, then the Mandarin for body and mind.

You'll want to know: xīntài

xīntài — "mindset; attitude of mind".

kǎoshì de shíhou xīntài zuì zhòngyào — In an exam, your mindset matters most.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīntài is built from 心 'heart' and *tài* 'a manner', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim* and *thojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'bearing and manner'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīntài*
- *Say it: xīntài*, once more
- *Say it: kǎoshì de shíhou xīntài zuì zhòngyào* — In an exam, your mindset matters most.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for get-up-and-go, then the Mandarin for body and mind, then say *xīntài* again

Before you move on

What does xīntài mean? ("Mindset; attitude of mind".) Say it once more.

485.5 jiǎnyā — to relieve stress

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for body and mind, then the Mandarin for a mindset.

You'll want to know: jiǎnyā

jiǎnyā — "to relieve stress".

tīng yīnyuè kěyǐ jiǎnyā — Listening to music helps relieve stress.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎnyā is built from *jiǎn* 'to lessen' and *yā* 'to press', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keamX* and *'aep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first under two readings and glosses *keamX* 'to reduce'; it glosses the second 'to press down'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎnyā*
- *Say it: jiǎnyā*, once more
- *Say it: tīng yīnyuè kěyǐ jiǎnyā* — Listening to music helps relieve stress.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for body and mind, then the Mandarin for a mindset, then say *jiǎnyā* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎnyā mean? ("To relieve stress".) Say it once more.

485.6 Looking back: from Is It Serious? to Body and Mind

Say the Mandarin for serious or urgent and how an illness is going.

Your turn

- *Say it:* serious or urgent, how an illness is going, the cause of an illness, to become infected, a virus
- *Say it:* the emergency department, to give medical treatment, a pill, to disinfect, to care for the sick
- *Say it:* to start to improve, to get well again, nourishment, looking after one's health, chronic
- *Say it:* to guard against, to give up drinking, to get into a habit, worn out, resistance to illness
- *Say it:* stress and pressure, get-up-and-go, body and mind, a mindset, to relieve stress
- *Read it:* 紧 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Serious or urgent? (要紧, *yàojǐn.*) How an illness is going? (病情, *bìngqíng.*) The cause of an illness? (病因, *bìngyīn.*) To become infected? (*gǎnrǎn.*) A virus? (*bìngdú.*) The emergency department? (*jízhěn.*) To give medical treatment? (*zhìliáo.*) A pill? (*yàopiàn.*) To disinfect? (*xiāodú.*) To care for the sick? (护理, *hùlǐ.*) To start to improve? (*hǎozhuǎn.*) To get well again? (*kāngfù.*) Nourishment? (*yíngyǎng.*) Looking after one's health? (*bǎojiàn.*) Chronic? (*mànxìng.*) To guard against? (*yùfáng.*) To give up drinking? (*jièjiǔ.*) To get into a habit? (*yǎngchéng.*) Worn out? (*píláo.*) Resistance to illness? (*dǐkànglì.*) Stress and pressure? (*yālì.*) Get-up-and-go? (*jīngshen.*) Body and mind? (身心, *shēnxīn.*) A mindset? (*xīntài.*) To relieve stress? (*jiǎnyā.*)

485.7 Body and Mind — once more

Say the Mandarin for stress and pressure and get-up-and-go.

Your turn

- *Say it:* stress and pressure, get-up-and-go, body and mind, a mindset, to relieve stress

Before you move on

Stress and pressure? (*yālì.*) Get-up-and-go? (*jīngshen.*) Body and mind? (身心, *shēnxīn.*) A mindset? (*xīntài.*) To relieve stress? (*jiǎnyā.*)

Chapter 486

Looking for Work

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about job adverts, a CV, applying for a job, an internship and pay and conditions.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 486: I can talk about job adverts, a CV, applying for a job, an internship and pay and conditions.*

486.1 zhāopìn — to recruit; to advertise a job

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for mindset, then the Mandarin for to relieve stress.

You'll want to know: zhāopìn

zhāopìn — "to recruit; to advertise a job".

> *zhè jiā gōngsī zhèngzài zhāopìn* — This company is hiring.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhāopìn is built from *zhāo* 'to beckon' and *pìn* 'to engage by invitation', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyew* and *phjiengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to call to' and the second 'a formal visit of inquiry'; the sense 'to hire' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhāopìn*
- *Say it: zhāopìn*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā gōngsī zhèngzài zhāopìn* — This company is hiring.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for mindset, then the Mandarin for to relieve stress, then say *zhāopìn* again

Before you move on

What does zhāopìn mean? ("To recruit; to advertise a job".) Say it once more.

486.2 jiǎnlì — CV; résumé

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to relieve stress, then the Mandarin for to recruit staff.

You'll want to know: jiǎnlì

jiǎnlì — "CV; résumé".

zhè shì wǒ de jiǎnlì — Here's my CV.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎnlì is built from *jiǎn* 'a writing slip; brief' and *lì* 'to pass through', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *keanX* and *lek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a writing tablet' and the second 'to pass through'. The sense 'a CV' is modern and not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎnlì*
- *Say it: jiǎnlì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ de jiǎnlì* — Here's my CV.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to relieve stress, then the Mandarin for to recruit staff, then say *jiǎnlì* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎnlì mean? ("CV; résumé".) Say it once more.

486.3 yìngpìn — to apply for a job

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to recruit staff, then the Mandarin for a CV.

You'll want to know: yìngpìn

yìngpìn — "to apply for a job".

> *qù yìngpìn de shíhou xīntài zuì zhòngyào* — When you go to apply for a job, your frame of mind matters most.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìngpìn is built from 应 'to answer' and *pìn* 'to engage by invitation', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'ingH* and *phjiengH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'things answering each other'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìngpìn*
- *Say it: yìngpìn*, once more
- *Say it: qù yìngpìn de shíhou xīntài zuì zhòngyào* — When you go to apply for a job, your frame of mind matters most.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to recruit staff, then the Mandarin for a CV, then say *yìngpìn* again

Before you move on

What does yìngpìn mean? ("To apply for a job".) Say it once more.

486.4 shíxí — to do an internship; to work as a trainee

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a CV, then the Mandarin for to apply for a job.

You'll want to know: shíxí

shíxí — "to do an internship; to work as a trainee".

wǒ zài yínháng shíxí le sān ge yuè — I did a three-month internship at a bank.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shíxí is built from *shí* 'real' and *xí* 'to practise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zyit* and *zip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'full' and 'true' and the second 'to learn'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shíxí*
- *Say it: shíxí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài yínháng shíxí le sān ge yuè* — I did a three-month internship at a bank.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a CV, then the Mandarin for to apply for a job, then say *shíxí* again

Before you move on

What does shíxí mean? ("To do an internship; to work as a trainee".) Say it once more.

486.5 dàiyù — pay and conditions (of a job)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to apply for a job, then the Mandarin for to do an internship.

You'll want to know: dàiyù

dàiyù — "pay and conditions (of a job)".

zhè jiā gōngsī de dàiyù bǐ nà jiā hǎo — This company pays better than that one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàiyù is built from *dài* 'to treat' and *yù* 'to meet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dojX* and *ngjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to wait for' and the second 'to meet without arranging it'; the sense 'how one is treated at work' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàiyù*
- *Say it: dàiyù*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā gōngsī de dàiyù bǐ nà jiā hǎo* — This company pays better than that one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to apply for a job, then the Mandarin for to do an internship, then say *dàiyù* again

Before you move on

What does dàiyù mean? ("Pay and conditions (of a job)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 487

A Career

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about lines of work, a career, finding a job, being out of work and factories.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 487: I can talk about lines of work, a career, finding a job, being out of work and factories.*

487.1 hángyè — line of business; industry

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to do an internship, then the Mandarin for pay and conditions.

You'll want to know: hángyè

hángyè — "line of business; industry".

> *nǐ zài nǎge hángyè gōngzuò* — What line of work are you in?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hángyè is built from *háng* 'a row' and *yè* 'a trade', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hang* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a file of soldiers' and the second 'affairs'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hángyè*
- *Say it: hángyè*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zài nǎge hángyè gōngzuò* — What line of work are you in?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to do an internship, then the Mandarin for pay and conditions, then say *hángyè* again

Before you move on

What does hángyè mean? ("Line of business; industry".) Say it once more.

487.2 事业 (shìyè) — career; life's work

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for pay and conditions, then the Mandarin for a line of business.

You'll want to know: 事业

事业 — *shìyè* — "career; life's work".

他觉得事业最重要 *tā juéde shìyè zuì zhòngyào* — He thinks his career matters most.

The new character, in pieces: 业 — five strokes and no piece you have written yet: two verticals side by side, a dot on the left and a short stroke falling left on the right, then a long bar along the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

事业 (*shìyè*) is built from 事 'a matter' and 业 'a trade', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzriH* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to employ' and the second

'affairs' and 'great'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shìyè*
- *Say it: shìyè*, once more
- *Say it: tā juéde shìyè zuì zhòngyào* — He thinks his career matters most.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for pay and conditions, then the Mandarin for a line of business, then say *shìyè* again

Before you move on

What does 事业 mean? ("Career; life's work".) Say it once more.

487.3 业 — two verticals, two short strokes, a long bar

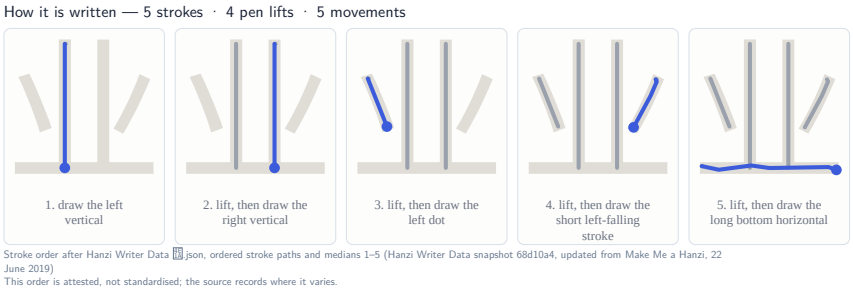
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shìyè* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  事 作

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *shì*, *zuò*

Script — two verticals, two short strokes, a long bar



How 业 is written, stroke by stroke

业

Five strokes, in three steps.

Two verticals first, side by side in the middle: the left one, then the right one, which starts a little higher.

Two short strokes outside them: a dot on the left that falls to the right, then a short stroke on the right that falls to the left.

Last, a long bar along the foot, wider than everything above it.

2 + 2 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 业, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 业 have? (**Five.**) What comes first? (**The two verticals.**) And last? (**The long bar along the foot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 业, pinned stroke paths and medians.

487.4 就业 (jiùyè) — to find employment; to get a job

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a line of business, then the Mandarin for one's life's work.

You'll want to know: 就业

就业 — *jiùyè* — "to find employment; to get a job".

> *xiànzài dàxuésheng jiùyè bù róngyì* — It isn't easy for graduates to find jobs these days.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

就业 (*jiùyè*) is built from 就 'to go to' and 业 'work', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjuwH* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to accomplish' and 'to go towards'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiùyè*
- *Say it: jiùyè*, once more
- *Say it: xiànzài dàxuésheng jiùyè bù róngyì* — It isn't easy for graduates to find jobs these days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a line of business, then the Mandarin for one's life's work, then say *jiùyè* again

Before you move on

What does 就业 mean? ("To find employment; to get a job".) Say it once more.

487.5 shīyè — to lose one's job; to be out of work

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's life's work, then the Mandarin for to find employment.

You'll want to know: shīyè

shīyè — "to lose one's job; to be out of work".

> *tā shīyè le bàn nián jīngshen hěn bù hǎo* — He was out of work for six months and was in very low spirits.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīyè is built from *shī* 'to lose' and 业 'work', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to err' and 'to let slip'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīyè*
- *Say it: shīyè*, once more
- *Say it: tā shīyè le bàn nián jīngshen hěn bù hǎo* — He was out of work for six months and was in very low spirits.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's life's work, then the Mandarin for to find employment, then say *shīyè* again

Before you move on

What does shīyè mean? ("To lose one's job; to be out of work".) Say it once more.

487.6 gōngchǎng — factory

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to find employment, then the Mandarin for to be out of work.

You'll want to know: gōngchǎng

gōngchǎng — "factory".

> *wǒ bàba zài gōngchǎng gōngzuò le èrshí nián* — My dad worked in a factory for twenty years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngchǎng is built from 工 'work' and *chǎng* 'a shed', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *tsyhangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'skilled work' and the second 'a roofed building'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngchǎng*
- *Say it: gōngchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bàba zài gōngchǎng gōngzuò le èrshí nián* — My dad worked in a factory for twenty years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to find employment, then the Mandarin for to be out of work, then say *gōngchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does gōngchǎng mean? ("Factory".) Say it once more.

Chapter 488

What Do You Want to Be

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I want to be: an engineer, a chef or a scientist, and talk about translating and earning.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 488: I can say what I want to be: an engineer, a chef or a scientist, and talk about translating and earning.*

488.1 gōngchéngshī — engineer

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be out of work, then the Mandarin for a factory.

You'll want to know: gōngchéngshī

gōngchéngshī — "engineer".

> *wǒ yǐhòu xiǎng dāng gōngchéngshī* — I want to be an engineer.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngchéngshī is built from 工 'work', *chéng* 'a measure' and *shī* 'a master', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng*, *drjeng* and *srij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a rule' and the third 'a model to follow'; the sense 'engineering' is modern and not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngchéngshī*
- *Say it: gōngchéngshī*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yǐhòu xiǎng dāng gōngchéngshī* — I want to be an engineer.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be out of work, then the Mandarin for a factory, then say *gōngchéngshī* again

Before you move on

What does gōngchéngshī mean? ("Engineer".) Say it once more.

488.2 chúshī — chef; professional cook

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a factory, then the Mandarin for an engineer.

You'll want to know: chúshī

chúshī — "chef; professional cook".

tā dāng le shí nián chúshī měi tiān dōu hěn píláo — He was a chef for ten years and was worn out every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chúshī is built from *chú* 'a kitchen' and *shī* 'a master', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drju* and *srij* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a kitchen' and the second 'a model to follow'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chúshī*
- *Say it: chúshī*, once more
- *Say it: tā dāng le shí nián chúshī měi tiān dōu hěn píláo* — He was a chef for ten years and was worn out every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a factory, then the Mandarin for an engineer, then say *chúshī* again

Before you move on

What does chúshī mean? ("Chef; professional cook".) Say it once more.

488.3 kēxuéjiā — scientist

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an engineer, then the Mandarin for a chef.

You'll want to know: kēxuéjiā

kēxuéjiā — "scientist".

xiǎoshíhou wǒ zuì xiǎng dāng kēxuéjiā — When I was little, what I wanted most was to be a scientist.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kēxuéjiā is built from *kē* 'a grade', 学 'to learn' and 家 'a household', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *khwa*, *haewk* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a rule' and 'a class'. The senses 'science' and 'someone skilled in it' are modern and not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kēxuéjiā*
- *Say it: kēxuéjiā*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou wǒ zuì xiǎng dāng kēxuéjiā* — When I was little, what I wanted most was to be a scientist.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an engineer, then the Mandarin for a chef, then say *kēxuéjiā* again

Before you move on

What does kēxuéjiā mean? ("Scientist".) Say it once more.

488.4 fānyì — to translate; to interpret

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a chef, then the Mandarin for a scientist.

You'll want to know: fānyì

fānyì — "to translate; to interpret".

nǐ néng bāng wǒ fānyì zhège ma — Can you translate this for me?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fānyì is built from *fān* 'to turn over' and *yì* 'to translate', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phjon* and *yek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to overturn' and the second 'to pass words on', the name of the interpreters for the peoples of the north.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fānyì*
- *Say it: fānyì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ néng bāng wǒ fānyì zhège ma* — Can you translate this for me?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a chef, then the Mandarin for a scientist, then say *fānyì* again

Before you move on

What does fānyì mean? ("To translate; to interpret".) Say it once more.

488.5 zhuàn — to earn money; to make a profit

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a scientist, then the Mandarin for to translate.

You'll want to know: zhuàn

zhuàn — "to earn money; to make a profit".

tā yí ge yuè zhuàn yíwàn kuài — He earns ten thousand yuan a month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuàn has no entry in the Guangyun, the dictionary this track cites for older forms. No dictionary we use records an older form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuàn*
- *Say it: zhuàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā yí ge yuè zhuàn yíwàn kuài* — He earns ten thousand yuan a month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a scientist, then the Mandarin for to translate, then say *zhuàn* again

Before you move on

What does zhuàn mean? ("To earn money; to make a profit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 489

On the Staff

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about changing employers, the staff, full-time jobs, posts and promotion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 489: I can talk about changing employers, the staff, full-time jobs, posts and promotion.*

489.1 tiàocáo — to move to another employer; to change jobs

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to translate, then the Mandarin for to earn money.

You'll want to know: tiàocáo

tiàocáo — "to move to another employer; to change jobs".

> *gōngzuò yālì tài dà suǒyǐ tā tiàocáo le* — The pressure at work was too much, so he moved to another firm.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiàocáo is built from *tiào* 'to jump' and *cáo* 'a trough', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dew* and *dzaw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to leap' and the second 'a horse's

trough'. A horse leaving one trough for the next is the picture usually given, but the dictionary does not give the sense.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiàocáo*
- *Say it: tiàocáo*, once more
- *Say it: gōngzuò yālì tài dà suǒyǐ tā tiàocáo le* — The pressure at work was too much, so he moved to another firm.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to translate, then the Mandarin for to earn money, then say *tiàocáo* again

Before you move on

What does tiàocáo mean? ("To move to another employer; to change jobs".) Say it once more.

489.2 职工 (zhígōng) — member of staff; employee (of a firm or factory)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to earn money, then the Mandarin for to move to another employer.

You'll want to know: 职工

职工 — *zhígōng* — "member of staff; employee (of a firm or factory)".

zhè jiā gōngchǎng yǒu yìbǎi ge zhígōng — This factory has a hundred staff.

The new character, in pieces: 职 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left an ear piece of six strokes, a bar, two verticals with two short bars between them and a stroke rising at the foot; on the right 只 *zhǐ*, five strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

职工 (*zhígōng*) is built from 职 'a post' and 工 'work', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyik* and *kuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be in charge of' and, after an older dictionary, 'an occupation'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhígōng*
- *Say it: zhígōng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā gōngchǎng yǒu yìbǎi ge zhígōng* — This factory has a hundred staff.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to earn money, then the Mandarin for to move to another employer, then say *zhígōng* again

Before you move on

What does 职工 mean? ("Member of staff; employee (of a firm or factory)".) Say it once more.

489.3 职 — an ear piece, then zhǐ

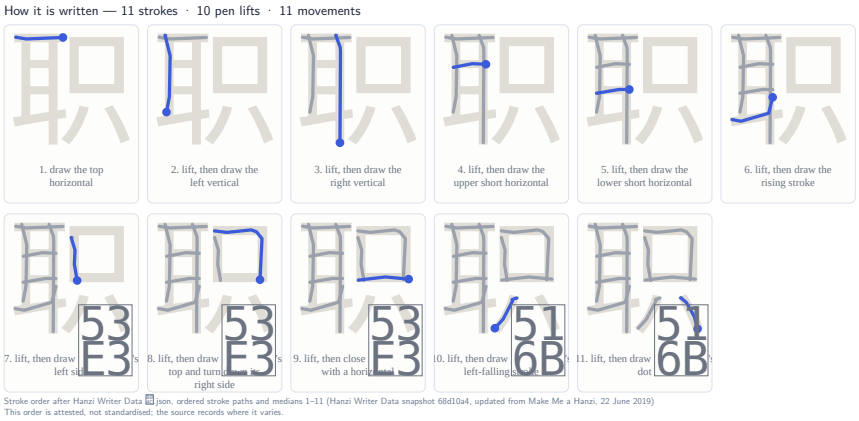
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhígōng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

只 工

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *zhǐ*, *gōng*

Script — an ear piece, then zhǐ



How 职 is written, stroke by stroke

职

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, six strokes. A bar on top. A short vertical on the left, then a long vertical on the right that runs down past everything else to the foot. Two short bars between them. Last, a stroke that rises to the right across the bottom.

The right piece, 只 *zhǐ*, five strokes, as you wrote it: 口 *kǒu*, then a stroke falling to the left and a dot falling to the right under it.

6 + 5 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 职, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 职 have? (**Two**.) What is the right piece read? (*zhǐ*.) Which stroke of the left piece runs longest? (**The vertical on its right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 职, pinned stroke paths and medians.

489.4 全职 (quánzhí) — full-time (of a job)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to move to another employer, then the Mandarin for a member of staff.

You'll want to know: 全职

全职 — *quánzhí* — "full-time (of a job)".

quánzhí de gōngzuò bǐ dǎgōng lèi — A full-time job is more tiring than casual work.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

全职 (*quánzhí*) is built from 全 'whole' and 职 'a post', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjwen* and *tsyik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'complete'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: quánzhí*
- *Say it: quánzhí*, once more
- *Say it: quánzhí de gōngzuò bǐ dǎgōng lèi* — A full-time job is more tiring than casual work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to move to another employer, then the Mandarin for a member of staff, then say *quánzhí* again

Before you move on

What does 全职 mean? ("Full-time (of a job)".) Say it once more.

489.5 zhíwèi — a position in a firm

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a member of staff, then the Mandarin for full-time (of a job).

You'll want to know: zhíwèi

zhíwèi — "a position in a firm".

> *tā xiǎng yào jīnglǐ de zhíwèi* — He wants the manager's job.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhíwèi is built from 职 'a post' and *wèi* 'a place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyik* and *hwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a rank in a row'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíwèi*
- *Say it: zhíwèi*, once more
- *Say it: tā xiǎng yào jīnglǐ de zhíwèi* — He wants the manager's job.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a member of staff, then the Mandarin for full-time (of a job), then say *zhíwèi* again

Before you move on

What does zhíwèi mean? ("A position in a firm".) Say it once more.

489.6 shēngzhí — to get promoted

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for full-time (of a job), then the Mandarin for a position in a firm.

You'll want to know: shēngzhí

shēngzhí — "to get promoted".

tā gōngzuò le wǔ nián cái shēngzhí — He worked five years before he was promoted.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēngzhí is built from *shēng* 'to rise' and 职 'a post', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sying* and *tsyik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a measure of grain and 'to complete'; the sense 'to rise' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngzhí*
- *Say it: shēngzhí*, once more
- *Say it: tā gōngzuò le wǔ nián cái shēngzhí* — He worked five years before he was promoted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for full-time (of a job), then the Mandarin for a position in a firm, then say *shēngzhí* again

Before you move on

What does shēngzhí mean? ("To get promoted".) Say it once more.

Chapter 490

Pressure at Work

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about managing, working together, night shifts, hard work and being fired.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 490: I can talk about managing, working together, night shifts, hard work and being fired.*

490.1 guǎnlǐ — to manage; to be in charge of

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a position in a firm, then the Mandarin for to get promoted.

You'll want to know: guǎnlǐ

guǎnlǐ — "to manage; to be in charge of".

> *tā guǎnlǐ yì jiā fàndiàn* — She manages a restaurant.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: guǎn is said with a rising tone before lǐ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guǎnlǐ is built from *guǎn* 'to be in charge' and 理 'to put in order', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwanX* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a pipe (a wind instrument)' and 'to be in charge', and the second 'to work jade' and 'a pattern'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǎnlǐ*
- *Say it: guǎnlǐ*, once more
- *Say it: tā guǎnlǐ yì jiā fàndiàn* — She manages a restaurant.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a position in a firm, then the Mandarin for to get promoted, then say *guǎnlǐ* again

Before you move on

What does guǎnlǐ mean? ("To manage; to be in charge of".) Say it once more.

490.2 hézuò — to work together; to cooperate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get promoted, then the Mandarin for to manage.

You'll want to know: hézuò

hézuò — "to work together; to cooperate".

gēn tā hézuò wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn — I really enjoy working with him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hézuò is built from *hé* 'to join' and 作 'to do', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hop* and *tsak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to join together' and the second 'to do' and 'to make'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hézuò*
- *Say it: hézuò*, once more
- *Say it: gēn tā hézuò wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn* — I really enjoy working with him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get promoted, then the Mandarin for to manage, then say *hézuò* again

Before you move on

What does hézuò mean? ("To work together; to cooperate".) Say it once more.

490.3 yèbān — night shift

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to manage, then the Mandarin for to work together.

You'll want to know: yèbān

yèbān — "night shift".

zuò le yì nián yèbān yǐhòu tā chángcháng shīmián — After a year of night shifts, he often couldn't sleep.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yèbān is built from *yè* 'night' and *bān* 'a shift', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yaeH* and *paen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'dusk' and the second 'to divide jade tokens'; the sense 'a turn of work' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yèbān*
- *Say it: yèbān*, once more
- *Say it: zuò le yì nián yèbān yǐhòu tā chángcháng shīmián* — After a year of night shifts, he often couldn't sleep.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to manage, then the Mandarin for to work together, then say *yèbān* again

Before you move on

What does yèbān mean? ("Night shift".) Say it once more.

490.4 xīnkǔ — exhausting; toilsome (of work)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to work together, then the Mandarin for the night shift.

You'll want to know: xīnkǔ

xīnkǔ — "exhausting; toilsome (of work)".

gōngzuò yālì dà de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn xīnkǔ — When the pressure at work is high, I find it really hard going.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xīnkǔ is built from *xīn* 'pungent' and *kǔ* 'bitter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sin* and *khuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the taste of ginger and the second 'coarse' and 'toil'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnkǔ*
- *Say it: xīnkǔ*, once more
- *Say it: gōngzuò yālì dà de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn xīnkǔ* — When the pressure at work is high, I find it really hard going.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to work together, then the Mandarin for the night shift, then say *xīnkǔ* again

Before you move on

What does xīnkǔ mean? ("Exhausting; toilsome (of work)".) Say it once more.

490.5 kāichú — to fire; to dismiss (from a job or school)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the night shift, then the Mandarin for exhausting (of work).

You'll want to know: kāichú

kāichú — "to fire; to dismiss (from a job or school)".

tā chángcháng chídào suǒyǐ lǎobǎn kāichú le tā — He was often late, so the boss fired him.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kāichú is built from 开 'to open' and *chú* 'to remove', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *drjo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to release' and the second 'to take away'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāichú*
- *Say it: kāichú*, once more
- *Say it: tā chángcháng chídào suǒyǐ lǎobǎn kāichú le tā* — He was often late, so the boss fired him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the night shift, then the Mandarin for exhausting (of work), then say *kāichú* again

Before you move on

What does kāichú mean? ("To fire; to dismiss (from a job or school)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 491

The Boss

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a pay rise, my superior, a secretary, the world of work and the people under me.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 491: I can talk about a pay rise, my superior, a secretary, the world of work and the people under me.*

491.1 jiāxīn — to get a pay rise; to raise someone's pay

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for exhausting (of work), then the Mandarin for to fire (from a job).

You'll want to know: jiāxīn

jiāxīn — "to get a pay rise; to raise someone's pay".

> *wǒ gōngzuò le liǎng nián hái méiyǒu jiāxīn* — I've worked for two years and still haven't had a pay rise.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiāxīn is built from *jiā* 'to add' and *xīn* 'firewood', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *sin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to increase' and the second 'firewood'. Firewood

standing for pay is the usual explanation, but the dictionary does not give that sense.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiāxīn*
- *Say it: jiāxīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gōngzuò le liǎng nián hái méiyǒu jiāxīn* — I've worked for two years and still haven't had a pay rise.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for exhausting (of work), then the Mandarin for to fire (from a job), then say *jiāxīn* again

Before you move on

What does jiāxīn mean? ("To get a pay rise; to raise someone's pay".) Say it once more.

491.2 上司 (shàngsi) — one's superior at work

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fire (from a job), then the Mandarin for to get a pay rise.

You'll want to know: 上司

上司 — *shàngsi* — "one's superior at work".

我的新上司比以前的好 *wǒ de xīn shàngsi bǐ yǐqián de hǎo* — My new boss is better than the last one.

The new character, in pieces: 司 — five strokes: one long stroke for the frame, a bar along the top that turns down the right side and hooks; a short bar under it; then 口 *kǒu* inside. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The second syllable is light: shàngsi, with no tone of its own.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上司 (*shàngsi*) is built from 上 'above' and 司 'to be in charge', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangH* and *si* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a ruler' and the second 'to be in charge'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngsi*
- *Say it: shàngsi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de xīn shàngsi bǐ yǐqián de hǎo* — My new boss is better than the last one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fire (from a job), then the Mandarin for to get a pay rise, then say *shàngsi* again

Before you move on

What does 上司 mean? ("One's superior at work".) Say it once more.

491.3 司 — a hooked frame, a short bar, then kǒu

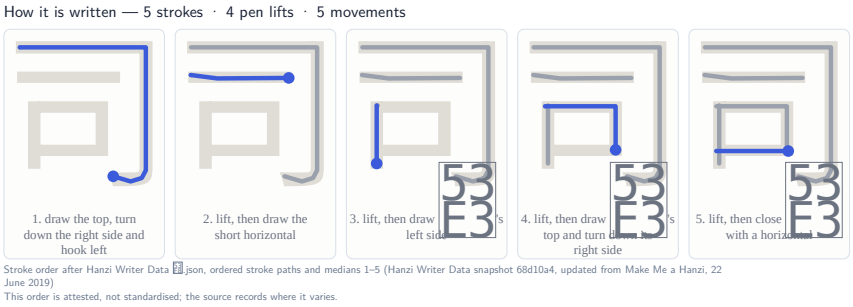
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shàngsi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

口 公

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kǒu*, *gōng*

Script — a hooked frame, a short bar, then kǒu



How 司 is written, stroke by stroke

司

The frame, one stroke. A bar along the top that turns down the right side and hooks to the left at the foot.

A short bar inside, under the top.

Then 口 *kǒu*, three strokes, under the short bar: the left side, the top that turns down, and the bottom.

1 + 1 + 3 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 司, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 司 have? (**Five.**) Which stroke comes first? (**The frame: a top bar that turns down and hooks.**) What sits inside? (**A short bar and 口.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 司, pinned stroke paths and medians.

491.4 mìshū — secretary

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get a pay rise, then the Mandarin for one's superior at work.

You'll want to know: mìshū

mìshū — "secretary".

> *wǒ zài gōngsī dāng le sān nián mìshū* — I was a secretary at a company for three years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mìshū is built from *mì* 'secret' and 书 'writing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pijH* and *syo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which lists the first in an older form, glossed 'close' and 'secret'. The modern mì is irregular: *pijH* would regularly give bì.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mìshū*
- *Say it: mìshū*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài gōngsī dāng le sān nián mìshū* — I was a secretary at a company for three years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get a pay rise, then the Mandarin for one's superior at work, then say *mìshū* again

Before you move on

What does mìshū mean? ("Secretary".) Say it once more.

491.5 职场 (zhíchǎng) — the workplace; the world of work

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's superior at work, then the Mandarin for a secretary.

You'll want to know: 职场

职场 — *zhíchǎng* — "the workplace; the world of work".

> *wǒ juéde zhíchǎng bǐ xuéxiào lèi* — I find working life more tiring than school.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

职场 (*zhíchǎng*) is built from 职 'a post' and 场 'a ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyik* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a threshing floor'; the modern third tone of chǎng is irregular for *drjang*.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhíchǎng*
- *Say it: zhíchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhíchǎng bǐ xuéxiào lèi* — I find working life more tiring than school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's superior at work, then the Mandarin for a secretary, then say *zhíchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 职场 mean? ("The workplace; the world of work".) Say it once more.

491.6 xiàshǔ — subordinate; someone under one at work

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a secretary, then the Mandarin for the world of work.

You'll want to know: xiàshǔ

xiàshǔ — "subordinate; someone under one at work".

> *tā de xiàshǔ dōu hěn yǒu jīngshen* — The people under him are all full of energy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàshǔ is built from 下 'below' and *shǔ* 'to belong to', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *dzyowk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'low' and the second 'attached to' and 'a kind'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàshǔ*
- *Say it: xiàshǔ*, once more
- *Say it: tā de xiàshǔ dōu hěn yǒu jīngshen* — The people under him are all full of energy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a secretary, then the Mandarin for the world of work, then say *xiàshǔ* again

Before you move on

What does xiàshǔ mean? ("Subordinate; someone under one at work".) Say it once more.

491.7 Looking back: from Looking for Work to The Boss

Say the Mandarin for to recruit staff and a CV.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to recruit staff, a CV, to apply for a job, to do an internship, pay and conditions
- *Say it:* a line of business, one's life's work, to find employment, to be out of work, a factory
- *Say it:* an engineer, a chef, a scientist, to translate, to earn money
- *Say it:* to move to another employer, a member of staff, full-time (of a job), a position in a firm, to get promoted
- *Say it:* to manage, to work together, the night shift, exhausting (of work), to fire (from a job)
- *Say it:* to get a pay rise, one's superior at work, a secretary, the world of work, someone under one at work
- *Read it:* 业 职 司 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To recruit staff? (*zhāopìn.*) A CV? (*jiǎnlì.*) To apply for a job? (*yìngpìn.*) To do an internship? (*shíxí.*) Pay and conditions? (*dàiyù.*) A line of business? (*hángyè.*) One's life's work? (事业, *shìyè.*) To find employment? (就业, *jiùyè.*) To be out of work? (*shīyè.*) A factory? (*gōngchǎng.*) An engineer? (*gōngchéngshī.*) A chef? (*chúshī.*) A scientist? (*kēxuéjiā.*) To translate? (*fānyì.*) To earn money? (*zhuàn.*) To move to another employer? (*tiàocáo.*) A member of staff? (职工, *zhígōng.*) Full-time (of a job)? (全职, *quánzhí.*) A position in a firm? (*zhíwèi.*) To get promoted? (*shēngzhí.*) To manage? (*guǎnlǐ.*) To work together? (*hézuò.*) The night shift? (*yèbān.*) Exhausting (of work)? (*xīnkǔ.*) To fire (from a job)? (*kāichú.*) To get a pay rise? (*jiāxīn.*) One's superior at work? (上司, *shàngsi.*) A secretary? (*mìshū.*) The world of work? (职场, *zhíchǎng.*) Someone under one at work? (*xiàshǔ.*)

Chapter 492

School Subjects

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name school subjects, say which one I like best and talk about my major.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 492: I can name school subjects, say which one I like best and talk about my major.*

492.1 语文 (yǔwén) — Chinese (as a school subject)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the world of work, then the Mandarin for someone under one at work.

You'll want to know: 语文

语文 — *yǔwén* — "Chinese (as a school subject)".

> 我最喜欢语文课 *wǒ zuì xǐhuan yǔwén kè* — Chinese is my favourite lesson.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

语文 (*yǔwén*) is built from 语 'speech' and 文 'writing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjoX* and *mjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to discuss' and the second 'a written piece'. The name of the school subject is modern and not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǔwén*
- *Say it: yǔwén*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì xǐhuan yǔwén kè* — Chinese is my favourite lesson.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the world of work, then the Mandarin for someone under one at work, then say *yǔwén* again

Before you move on

What does 语文 mean? ("Chinese (as a school subject)".) Say it once more.

492.2 shùxué — maths; mathematics

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for someone under one at work, then the Mandarin for Chinese (as a school subject).

You'll want to know: shùxué

shùxué — "maths; mathematics".

wǒ de shùxué bǐ yǔwén hǎo — I'm better at maths than at Chinese.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shùxué is built from *shù* 'a number' and 学 'to learn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjuH* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'reckoning' and names the nine arts of reckoning of an old book of rites.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shùxué*
- *Say it: shùxué*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de shùxué bǐ yǔwén hǎo* — I'm better at maths than at Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for someone under one at work, then the Mandarin for Chinese (as a school subject), then say *shùxué* again

Before you move on

What does shùxué mean? ("Maths; mathematics".) Say it once more.

492.3 地理 (dìlǐ) — geography

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for Chinese (as a school subject), then the Mandarin for maths.

You'll want to know: 地理

地理 — *dìlǐ* — "geography".

wǒmen de dìlǐ lǎoshī hěn yǒuyìsi — Our geography teacher is really interesting.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

地理 (*dìlǐ*) is built from 地 'the land' and 理 'a pattern', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *liX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the earth' and the second 'to work jade' and 'a pattern'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìlǐ*
- *Say it: dìlǐ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de dìlǐ lǎoshī hěn yǒuyìsi* — Our geography teacher is really interesting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for Chinese (as a school subject), then the Mandarin for maths, then say *dìlǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 地理 mean? ("Geography".) Say it once more.

492.4 Yīngyǔ — English (the language)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for maths, then the Mandarin for geography.

You'll want to know: Yīngyǔ

Yīngyǔ — "English (the language)".

wǒ xué le liù nián Yīngyǔ — I studied English for six years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Yīngyǔ is built from *Yīng*, short for the name of England, and 语 'speech', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jaeng* and *ngjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a flower'; the first stands for the country only in modern use.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: Yīngyǔ*
- *Say it: Yīngyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xué le liù nián Yīngyǔ* — I studied English for six years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for maths, then the Mandarin for geography, then say *Yīngyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does Yīngyǔ mean? ("English (the language)".) Say it once more.

492.5 zhuānyè — major; field of study

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for geography, then the Mandarin for English (the language).

You'll want to know: zhuānyè

zhuānyè — "major; field of study".

nǐ de zhuānyè shì shénme — What's your major?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuānyè is built from *zhuān* 'single-minded' and 业 'a trade', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsywen* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'alone' and 'to have to oneself'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuānyè*
- *Say it: zhuānyè*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de zhuānyè shì shénme* — What's your major?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for geography, then the Mandarin for English (the language), then say *zhuānyè* again

Before you move on

What does zhuānyè mean? ("Major; field of study".) Say it once more.

Chapter 493

Extra Lessons

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about extra lessons, a private tutor, education, tutoring and asking for advice.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 493: I can talk about extra lessons, a private tutor, education, tutoring and asking for advice.*

493.1 bǔxí — to take extra lessons

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for English (the language), then the Mandarin for a major (at university).

You'll want to know: bǔxí

bǔxí — "to take extra lessons".

> *wǒ bǔxí le yì nián shùxué* — I had extra maths lessons for a year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǔxí is built from *bǔ* 'to patch' and *xí* 'to practise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *puX* and *zip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to mend clothes' and the second 'to learn'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǔxí*
- *Say it: bǔxí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bǔxí le yì nián shùxué* — I had extra maths lessons for a year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for English (the language), then the Mandarin for a major (at university), then say *bǔxí* again

Before you move on

What does bǔxí mean? ("To take extra lessons".) Say it once more.

493.2 家教 (jiājiào) — private tutor

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a major (at university), then the Mandarin for to take extra lessons.

You'll want to know: 家教

家教 — *jiājiào* — "private tutor".

大学的时候我当过家教 *dàxué de shíhou wǒ dāng guo jiājiào* — At university I worked as a private tutor.

The new character, in pieces: 教 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left the top of 老 *lǎo* with 子 *zǐ* tucked under it, seven strokes; on the right four strokes, two falling to the left, a short bar and a long stroke falling to the right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

家教 (*jiājiào*) is built from 家 'a home' and 教 'to teach', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *kaewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to instruct'. Here 教 keeps the

falling tone, jiào.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiājiào*
- *Say it: jiājiào*, once more
- *Say it: dàxué de shíhou wǒ dāng guo jiājiào* — At university I worked as a private tutor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a major (at university), then the Mandarin for to take extra lessons, then say *jiājiào* again

Before you move on

What does 家教 mean? ("Private tutor".) Say it once more.

493.3 教 — the top of lǎo over zǐ, then four strokes

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *jiājiào* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  老 子 家

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lǎo*, *zǐ*, *jiā*

Script — the top of lǎo over zǐ, then four strokes

How 教 *is written, stroke by stroke*

教

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, seven strokes. First the top of 老, four strokes, as you wrote them: a short bar, a vertical through it, a long bar, and a long stroke falling to the left. Then 子 *zǐ*, three strokes, tucked under it: a bar that turns and falls to the left, a vertical with a hook, and a stroke rising to the right.

The right piece, four strokes: a short stroke falling to the left, a bar, a long stroke falling to the left, and a long stroke falling to the right.

4 + 3 + 4 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 教, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 教 have? (**Two**.) What starts the left piece? (**The top of** 老.) What sits under it? (子.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 教, pinned stroke paths and medians.

493.4 jiàoyù — to educate; to bring up (the young); education

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take extra lessons, then the Mandarin for a private tutor.

You'll want to know: jiàoyù

jiàoyù — "to educate; to bring up (the young); education".

jiàoyù háizi bù róngyì — Bringing up children isn't easy.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiàoyù is built from 教 'to instruct' and *yù* 'to rear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaewH* and *yuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to instruct' and the second 'to nourish' and 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiàoyù*
- *Say it: jiàoyù*, once more
- *Say it: jiàoyù háizi bù róngyì* — Bringing up children isn't easy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take extra lessons, then the Mandarin for a private tutor, then say *jiàoyù* again

Before you move on

What does jiàoyù mean? ("To educate; to bring up (the young); education".) Say it once more.

493.5 fǔdǎo — to tutor; to give guidance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a private tutor, then the Mandarin for to educate.

You'll want to know: fǔdǎo

fǔdǎo — "to tutor; to give guidance".

jiějie měi tiān wǎnshang fǔdǎo wǒ zuò zuòyè — My sister helps me with my homework every evening.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: fǔ is said with a rising tone before dǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fǔdǎo is built from *fǔ* 'to help' and *dǎo* 'to lead', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuX* and *dawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to assist' and the second 'to guide'. Both modern third tones are irregular: *bjuX* and *dawH* would regularly give fù and dào.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fǔdǎo*
- *Say it: fǔdǎo*, once more
- *Say it: jiějie měi tiān wǎnshang fǔdǎo wǒ zuò zuòyè* — My sister helps me with my homework every evening.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a private tutor, then the Mandarin for to educate, then say *fǔdǎo* again

Before you move on

What does fǔdǎo mean? ("To tutor; to give guidance".) Say it once more.

493.6 请教 (qǐngjiào) — to seek advice (from someone who knows more)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to educate, then the Mandarin for to tutor.

You'll want to know: 请教

请教 — *qǐngjiào* — "to seek advice (from someone who knows more)".

我常常请教我的上司 *wǒ chángcháng qǐngjiào wǒ de shàngsi* — I often ask my boss for advice.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

请教 (*qǐngjiào*) is built from 请 'to ask' and 教 'to instruct', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjengX* and *kaewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to beg' and 'to ask'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐngjiào*
- *Say it: qǐngjiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ chángcháng qǐngjiào wǒ de shàngsi* — I often ask my boss for advice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to educate, then the Mandarin for to tutor, then say *qǐngjiào* again

Before you move on

What does **请教** mean? ("To seek advice (from someone who knows more)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 494

The Entrance Exam

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the college entrance exam, the candidates, applying, getting in and failing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 494: I can talk about the college entrance exam, the candidates, applying, getting in and failing.*

494.1 高考 (gāokǎo) — college entrance exam

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to tutor, then the Mandarin for to seek advice.

You'll want to know: 高考

高考 — *gāokǎo* — "college entrance exam".

> *gāokǎo de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn jǐnzhāng* — I felt very nervous during the entrance exam.

The new character, in pieces: 考 — six strokes: the top of 老 *lǎo*, four strokes, then a short bar and a stroke that drops, runs right, turns down and hooks. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

高考 (*gāokǎo*) is built from 高 'high' and 考 'to examine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *khawX* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to check' and 'to complete'. It is short for a longer official name, the exam for the higher schools.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāokǎo*
- *Say it: gāokǎo*, once more
- *Say it: gāokǎo de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn jǐnzhāng* — I felt very nervous during the entrance exam.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to tutor, then the Mandarin for to seek advice, then say *gāokǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 高考 mean? ("College entrance exam".) Say it once more.

494.2 考 — the top of lǎo, then two strokes

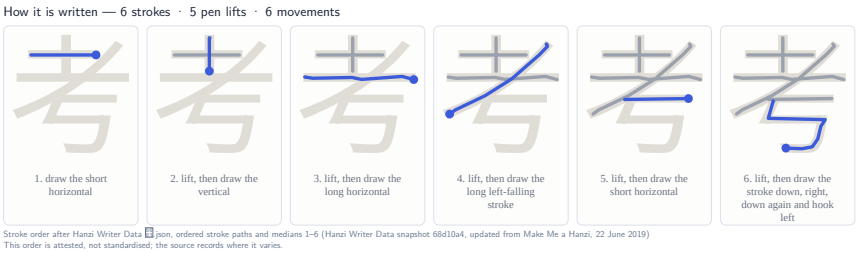
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gāokǎo* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  老 高

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lǎo*, *gāo*

Script — the top of lǎo, then two strokes



How 考 is written, stroke by stroke

考

The top of 老, four strokes, as in 老 and on the left of 教: a short bar, a vertical through it, a long bar, and a long stroke falling to the left.

Then two strokes under it: a short bar, and a stroke that starts under the bar's left end, drops a little, runs right, then turns down and hooks to the left.

4 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 考, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 考 have? (**Six.**) What are the first four? (**The top of 老.**) How does the last stroke end? (**It turns down and hooks to the left.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 考, pinned stroke paths and medians.

494.3 考生 (kǎoshēng) — exam candidate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to seek advice, then the Mandarin for the college entrance exam.

You'll want to know: 考生

考生 — *kǎoshēng* — "exam candidate".

kǎoshēng dōu hěn jǐnzhāng — The candidates are all nervous.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

考生 (*kǎoshēng*) is built from 考 'to examine' and 生 'a student', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khawX* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǎoshēng*
- *Say it: kǎoshēng*, once more
- *Say it: kǎoshēng dōu hěn jǐnzhāng* — The candidates are all nervous.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to seek advice, then the Mandarin for the college entrance exam, then say *kǎoshēng* again

Before you move on

What does 考生 mean? ("Exam candidate".) Say it once more.

494.4 报考 (bàokǎo) — to enter for an exam; to apply to a school by exam

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the college entrance exam, then the Mandarin for an exam candidate.

You'll want to know: 报考

报考 — *bàokǎo* — "to enter for an exam; to apply to a school by exam".

wǒ xiǎng bàokǎo Běijīng de dàxué — I want to apply to universities in Beijing.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

报考 (*bàokǎo*) is built from 报 'to report' and 考 'to examine', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pawH* and *khawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to report'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bàokǎo*
- *Say it: bàokǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng bàokǎo Běijīng de dàxué* — I want to apply to universities in Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the college entrance exam, then the Mandarin for an exam candidate, then say *bàokǎo* again

Before you move on

What does 报考 mean? ("To enter for an exam; to apply to a school by exam".) Say it once more.

494.5 考上 (kǎoshàng) — to get into (a school) by exam; to pass the entrance exam for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an exam candidate, then the Mandarin for to enter for an exam.

You'll want to know: 考上

考上 — *kǎoshàng* — "to get into (a school) by exam; to pass the entrance exam for".

tā fùxí le yì nián cái kǎoshàng dàxué — He revised for a year before he got into university.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

考上 (*kǎoshàng*) is built from 考 'to examine' and 上 'to go up', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khawX* and *dzyangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to climb'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǎoshàng*
- *Say it: kǎoshàng*, once more
- *Say it: tā fùxí le yì nián cái kǎoshàng dàxué* — He revised for a year before he got into university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an exam candidate, then the Mandarin for to enter for an exam, then say *kǎoshàng* again

Before you move on

What does 考上 mean? ("To get into (a school) by exam; to pass the entrance exam for".) Say it once more.

494.6 luòbǎng — to fail an entrance exam

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to enter for an exam, then the Mandarin for to pass the entrance exam for.

You'll want to know: luòbǎng

luòbǎng — "to fail an entrance exam".

luòbǎng yǐhòu tā gǎnjué hěn nánguò — After he failed the entrance exam, he felt awful.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

luòbǎng is built from *luò* 'to fall' and *bǎng* 'a board', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lak* and *pangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as leaves falling and the second 'a wooden board'. Falling off the list of names posted on a board is the usual explanation, but the dictionary does not give that sense.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: luòbǎng*
- *Say it: luòbǎng*, once more
- *Say it: luòbǎng yǐhòu tā gǎnjué hěn nánguò* — After he failed the entrance exam, he felt awful.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to enter for an exam, then the Mandarin for to pass the entrance exam for, then say *luòbǎng* again

Before you move on

What does luòbǎng mean? ("To fail an entrance exam".) Say it once more.

Chapter 495

Marks

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a midterm exam, the exam hall, full marks, cheating and hard questions.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 495: I can talk about a midterm exam, the exam hall, full marks, cheating and hard questions.*

495.1 期中 (qīzhōng) — the middle of the term; midterm

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pass the entrance exam for, then the Mandarin for to fail an entrance exam.

You'll want to know: 期中

期中 — *qīzhōng* — "the middle of the term; midterm".

> *zhè cì qīzhōng kǎoshì wǒ gǎnjué hái xíng* — I think this midterm went all right.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

期中 (*qīzhōng*) is built from 期 'a set time' and 中 'the middle', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gi* and *trjuwng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'an appointed time'. The modern first tone of qī is irregular: *gi* would regularly give qí.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīzhōng*
- *Say it: qīzhōng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè cì qīzhōng kǎoshì wǒ gǎnjué hái xíng* — I think this midterm went all right.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pass the entrance exam for, then the Mandarin for to fail an entrance exam, then say *qīzhōng* again

Before you move on

What does 期中 mean? ("The middle of the term; midterm".) Say it once more.

495.2 考场 (kǎochǎng) — exam hall; exam room

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fail an entrance exam, then the Mandarin for the middle of the term.

You'll want to know: 考场

考场 — *kǎochǎng* — "exam hall; exam room".

进考场以前我喝了一杯水 *jìn kǎochǎng yǐqián wǒ hē le yì bēi shuǐ* — Before going into the exam hall, I drank a glass of water.

Two third tones meet in this word: kǎo is said with a rising tone before chǎng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

考场 (*kǎochǎng*) is built from 考 'to examine' and 场 'a ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khawX* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a threshing floor'; the third tone of chǎng is irregular for *drjang*.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kǎochǎng*
- *Say it: kǎochǎng*, once more
- *Say it: jìn kǎochǎng yǐqián wǒ hē le yì bēi shuǐ* — Before going into the exam hall, I drank a glass of water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fail an entrance exam, then the Mandarin for the middle of the term, then say *kǎochǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 考场 mean? ("Exam hall; exam room".) Say it once more.

495.3 mǎnfēn — full marks

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the middle of the term, then the Mandarin for an exam hall.

You'll want to know: mǎnfēn

mǎnfēn — "full marks".

zhè cì shùxué kǎoshì tā shì mǎnfēn — He got full marks in this maths test.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mǎnfēn is built from *mǎn* 'full' and *fēn* 'a part', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *manX* and *pjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'brimming' and the second 'to divide'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎnfēn*
- *Say it: mǎnfēn*, once more
- *Say it: zhè cì shùxué kǎoshì tā shì mǎnfēn* — He got full marks in this maths test.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the middle of the term, then the Mandarin for an exam hall, then say *mǎnfēn* again

Before you move on

What does mǎnfēn mean? ("Full marks".) Say it once more.

495.4 zuòbì — to cheat in an exam

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an exam hall, then the Mandarin for full marks.

You'll want to know: zuòbì

zuòbì — "to cheat in an exam".

kǎoshì de shíhou bù yīnggāi zuòbì — You shouldn't cheat in an exam.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuòbì is built from 作 'to do' and *bì* 'harm', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsak* and *bjiejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'worn out' and 'bad'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòbì*
- *Say it: zuòbì*, once more
- *Say it: kǎoshì de shíhou bù yīnggāi zuòbì* — You shouldn't cheat in an exam.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an exam hall, then the Mandarin for full marks, then say *zuòbì* again

Before you move on

What does zuòbì mean? ("To cheat in an exam".) Say it once more.

495.5 难题 (nántí) — hard problem; difficult question

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for full marks, then the Mandarin for to cheat in an exam.

You'll want to know: 难题

难题 — *nántí* — "hard problem; difficult question".

这个难题我想了一个小时 *zhège nántí wǒ xiǎng le yí ge xiǎoshí* — I spent an hour thinking about this hard question.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

难题 (*nántí*) is built from 难 'hard' and 题 'a heading', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan* and *dej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'hard to do' and the second 'a written heading'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: nántí*
- *Say it: nántí*, once more
- *Say it: zhège nántí wǒ xiǎng le yí ge xiǎoshí* — I spent an hour thinking about this hard question.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for full marks, then the Mandarin for to cheat in an exam, then say *nántí* again

Before you move on

What does 难题 mean? ("Hard problem; difficult question".) Say it once more.

Chapter 496

Levels

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about learning by heart, advanced, intermediate and elementary levels, and repeating a year.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 496: I can talk about learning by heart, advanced, intermediate and elementary levels, and repeating a year.*

496.1 bèishū — to learn a text by heart; to recite from memory

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to cheat in an exam, then the Mandarin for a hard problem.

You'll want to know: bèishū

bèishū — "to learn a text by heart; to recite from memory".

> *kǎoshì yǐqián wǒ měi tiān zǎoshang bèishū* — Before exams I learn my texts by heart every morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bèishū is built from *bèi* 'the back' and 书 'a book', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwojH* and *syo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription),

which glosses the first 'the back of the body' and also lists it as *bwojH*, 'to turn one's back on'. How the pair came to mean 'to recite from memory' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bèishū*
- *Say it: bèishū*, once more
- *Say it: kǎoshì yǐqián wǒ měi tiān zǎoshang bèishū* — Before exams I learn my texts by heart every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to cheat in an exam, then the Mandarin for a hard problem, then say *bèishū* again

Before you move on

What does bèishū mean? ("To learn a text by heart; to recite from memory".) Say it once more.

496.2 高级 (gāojí) — advanced; high-level

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a hard problem, then the Mandarin for to learn a text by heart.

You'll want to know: 高级

高级 — *gāojí* — "advanced; high-level".

我学了三年汉语现在学高级汉语 *wǒ xué le sān nián Hànyǔ xiànzài xué gāojí Hànyǔ* — I've studied Chinese for three years, and now I'm doing advanced Chinese.

The new character, in pieces: 级 — six strokes in two pieces: on the left the silk piece of 红 *hóng*, three strokes; on the right three strokes, a long stroke falling left, a stroke that runs right and turns twice, and a long stroke falling right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

高级 (*gāojí*) is built from 高 'high' and 级 'a grade', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaw* and *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a grade' and, after an older dictionary, 'the order of silk threads'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāojí*
- *Say it: gāojí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xué le sān nián Hànyǔ xiànzài xué gāojí Hànyǔ* — I've studied Chinese for three years, and now I'm doing advanced Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a hard problem, then the Mandarin for to learn a text by heart, then say *gāojí* again

Before you move on

What does 高级 mean? ("Advanced; high-level".) Say it once more.

496.3 级 — the silk piece, then three strokes

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *gāojí* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  红 高

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *hóng*, *gāo*

Script — the silk piece, then three strokes

How 级 is written, stroke by stroke

级

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, three strokes, as on the left of 红: a stroke that falls to the left and turns right, a second one like it below, then a short stroke rising to the right.

The right piece, three strokes: a long stroke falling to the left; then one stroke that runs right along the top, turns down and back, runs right again and falls away to the lower left; then a long stroke falling to the right.

3 + 3 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 级, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 级 have? (**Two.**) Which characters you know share its left piece? (**红, 经 or 约.**) What is the last stroke? (**A long stroke falling to the right.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 级, pinned stroke paths and medians.

496.4 中级 (zhōngjí) — intermediate (in level)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to learn a text by heart, then the Mandarin for advanced (in level).

You'll want to know: 中级

中级 — *zhōngjí* — "intermediate (in level)".

> 我在公司学中级汉语 *wǒ zài gōngsī xué zhōngjí Hànyǔ* — I'm taking intermediate Chinese at work.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

中级 (*zhōngjí*) is built from 中 'the middle' and 级 'a grade', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwng* and *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōngjí*
- *Say it: zhōngjí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài gōngsī xué zhōngjí Hànyǔ* — I'm taking intermediate Chinese at work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to learn a text by heart, then the Mandarin for advanced (in level), then say *zhōngjí* again

Before you move on

What does 中级 mean? ("Intermediate (in level)".) Say it once more.

496.5 chūjí — elementary; for beginners

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for advanced (in level), then the Mandarin for intermediate (in level).

You'll want to know: chūjí

chūjí — "elementary; for beginners".

wǒ xué guo chūjí Hànyǔ — I've done elementary Chinese.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chūjí is built from *chū* 'the start' and 级 'a grade', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhjo* and *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the beginning'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūjí*
- *Say it: chūjí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xué guo chūjí Hànyǔ* — I've done elementary Chinese.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for advanced (in level), then the Mandarin for intermediate (in level), then say *chūjí* again

Before you move on

What does chūjí mean? ("Elementary; for beginners".) Say it once more.

496.6 liújí — to repeat a school year

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for intermediate (in level), then the Mandarin for elementary (in level).

You'll want to know: liújí

liújí — "to repeat a school year".

tā de chéngjì bù hǎo liújí le — His marks were poor, so he had to repeat the year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liújí is built from *liú* 'to stay' and 级 'a grade', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljuw* and *kip* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stay' and 'to stop'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: liújí*
- *Say it: liújí*, once more
- *Say it: tā de chéngjì bù hǎo liújí le* — His marks were poor, so he had to repeat the year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for intermediate (in level), then the Mandarin for elementary (in level), then say *liújí* again

Before you move on

What does liújí mean? ("To repeat a school year".) Say it once more.

Chapter 497

Learning on Your Own

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about teaching myself, time outside class, notes, knowledge and going on to further study.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 497: I can talk about teaching myself, time outside class, notes, knowledge and going on to further study.*

497.1 自学 (zìxué) — to teach oneself

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for elementary (in level), then the Mandarin for to repeat a school year.

You'll want to know: 自学

自学 — *zìxué* — "to teach oneself".

> 我自学了两年汉语现在是中级 *wǒ zìxué le liǎng nián Hànyǔ xiànzài shì zhōngjí* — I taught myself Chinese for two years, and now I'm at intermediate level.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

自学 (*zìxué*) is built from 自 'oneself' and 学 'to learn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'from'; the sense 'oneself' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìxué*
- *Say it: zìxué*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zìxué le liǎng nián Hànyǔ xiànzài shì zhōngjí* — I taught myself Chinese for two years, and now I'm at intermediate level.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for elementary (in level), then the Mandarin for to repeat a school year, then say *zìxué* again

Before you move on

What does 自学 mean? ("To teach oneself".) Say it once more.

497.2 课外 (kèwài) — outside class; extracurricular

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to repeat a school year, then the Mandarin for to teach oneself.

You'll want to know: 课外

课外 — *kèwài* — "outside class; extracurricular".

我还没有做课外作业 *wǒ hái méiyǒu zuò kèwài zuòyè* — I haven't done my homework yet.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

课外 (*kèwài*) is built from 课 'a lesson' and 外 'outside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khwaH* and *ngwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a tax' and 'to test' and the second 'the outside'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kèwài*
- *Say it: kèwài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hái méiyǒu zuò kèwài zuòyè* — I haven't done my homework yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to repeat a school year, then the Mandarin for to teach oneself, then say *kèwài* again

Before you move on

What does 课外 mean? ("Outside class; extracurricular".) Say it once more.

497.3 bǐjì — notes (taken in class)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to teach oneself, then the Mandarin for outside class.

You'll want to know: bǐjì

bǐjì — "notes (taken in class)".

nǐ de bǐjì xiě de hěn hǎo — Your notes are really well written.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǐjì is built from *bǐ* 'a brush' and 记 'to record', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pit* and *kiH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to record'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǐjì*
- *Say it: bǐjì*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ de bǐjì xiě de hěn hǎo* — Your notes are really well written.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to teach oneself, then the Mandarin for outside class, then say *bǐjì* again

Before you move on

What does bǐjì mean? ("Notes (taken in class)".) Say it once more.

497.4 zhīshi — knowledge

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for outside class, then the Mandarin for notes (taken in class).

You'll want to know: zhīshi

zhīshi — "knowledge".

zhīshi bǐ qián zhòngyào — Knowledge matters more than money.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhīshi is built from *zhī* 'to know' and *shí* 'to recognise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trje* and *syik* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to perceive' and the second 'to know'; in the word the second syllable is light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhīshi*
- *Say it: zhīshi*, once more
- *Say it: zhīshi bǐ qián zhòngyào* — Knowledge matters more than money.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for outside class, then the Mandarin for notes (taken in class), then say *zhīshi* again

Before you move on

What does zhīshi mean? ("Knowledge".) Say it once more.

497.5 shēngxué — to go on to a higher school; to go on to further study

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for notes (taken in class), then the Mandarin for knowledge.

You'll want to know: shēngxué

shēngxué — "to go on to a higher school; to go on to further study".

gāozhōng bìyè yǐhòu tā méiyǒu shēngxué — After senior high he didn't go on to further study.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shēngxué is built from *shēng* 'to rise' and 学 'to learn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sying* and *haewk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the sense 'to rise' is not given for the first there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shēngxué*
- *Say it: shēngxué*, once more
- *Say it: gāozhōng bìyè yǐhòu tā méiyǒu shēngxué* — After senior high he didn't go on to further study.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for notes (taken in class), then the Mandarin for knowledge, then say *shēngxué* again

Before you move on

What does shēngxué mean? ("To go on to a higher school; to go on to further study".) Say it once more.

497.6 Looking back: from School Subjects to Learning on Your Own

Say the Mandarin for Chinese (as a school subject) and maths.

Your turn

- *Say it:* Chinese (as a school subject), maths, geography, English (the language), a major (at university)
- *Say it:* to take extra lessons, a private tutor, to educate, to tutor, to seek advice
- *Say it:* the college entrance exam, an exam candidate, to enter for an exam, to pass the entrance exam for, to fail an entrance exam
- *Say it:* the middle of the term, an exam hall, full marks, to cheat in an exam, a hard problem
- *Say it:* to learn a text by heart, advanced (in level), intermediate (in level), elementary (in level), to repeat a school year
- *Say it:* to teach oneself, outside class, notes (taken in class), knowledge, to go on to further study
- *Read it:* 教 考 级 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Chinese (as a school subject)? (**语文**, *yǔwén.*) Maths? (*shùxué.*) Geography? (**地理**, *dìlǐ.*) English (the language)? (*Yīngyǔ.*) A major (at university)? (*zhuānyè.*) To take extra lessons? (*bǔxí.*) A private tutor? (**家教**, *jiājiào.*) To educate? (*jiàoyù.*) To tutor? (*fǔdǎo.*) To seek advice? (**请教**, *qǐngjiào.*) The college entrance exam? (**高考**, *gāokǎo.*) An exam candidate? (**考生**, *kǎoshēng.*) To enter for an exam? (**报考**, *bàokǎo.*) To pass the entrance exam for? (**考上**, *kǎoshàng.*) To fail an entrance exam? (*luòbǎng.*) The middle of the term? (**期中**, *qīzhōng.*) An exam hall? (**考场**, *kǎochǎng.*) Full marks? (*mǎnfēn.*) To cheat in an exam? (*zuòbì.*) A hard problem? (**难题**, *nántí.*) To learn a text by heart? (*bèishū.*) Advanced (in level)? (**高级**, *gāojí.*) Intermediate (in level)? (**中级**, *zhōngjí.*) Elementary (in level)? (*chūjí.*) To repeat a school year? (*liújí.*) To teach oneself? (**自学**, *zìxué.*) Outside class? (**课外**, *kèwài.*) Notes (taken in class)? (*bǐjì.*) Knowledge? (*zhīshi.*) To go on to further study? (*shēngxué.*)

Chapter 498

On the Pitch

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about PE, a pitch, the ball, the goalmouth and scoring a goal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 498: I can talk about PE, a pitch, the ball, the goalmouth and scoring a goal.*

498.1 tǐyù — physical education (a school subject)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for knowledge, then the Mandarin for to go on to further study.

You'll want to know: tǐyù

tǐyù — "physical education (a school subject)".

wǒ zuì xǐhuan de kè shì tǐyù — My favourite lesson is PE.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tǐyù is built from 体 'the body' and *yù* 'to rear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thejX* and *yuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the body' and the second 'to nourish' and 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tǐyù*
- *Say it: tǐyù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì xǐhuan de kè shì tǐyù* — My favourite lesson is PE.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for knowledge, then the Mandarin for to go on to further study, then say *tǐyù* again

Before you move on

What does tǐyù mean? ("Physical education (a school subject)".) Say it once more.

498.2 球场 (qiúchǎng) — sports ground; pitch; court

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to go on to further study, then the Mandarin for physical education.

You'll want to know: 球场

球场 — *qiúchǎng* — "sports ground; pitch; court".

wǒmen zài qiúchǎng tī le yí ge xiàwǔ zúqiú — We played football on the pitch all afternoon.

The new character, in pieces: 球 — eleven strokes in two pieces: on the left the jade piece of 理 *lǐ*, four strokes; on the right seven strokes, a bar, a long vertical with a hook, a dot and a rising stroke on the left, a short and a long falling stroke on the right, and a last dot at the top right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

球场 (*qiúchǎng*) is built from *qiú* 'a ball' and 场 'a ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a threshing floor'. It glosses the first character 'a fine jade'; the sense 'a ball' belongs to a second character with the same sound, glossed 'a ball of hair to be struck', which modern writing spells the same way.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúchǎng*
- *Say it: qiúchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zài qiúchǎng tī le yí ge xiàwǔ zúqiú* — We played football on the pitch all afternoon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to go on to further study, then the Mandarin for physical education, then say *qiúchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 球场 mean? ("Sports ground; pitch; court".) Say it once more.

498.3 球 — the jade piece, then seven strokes

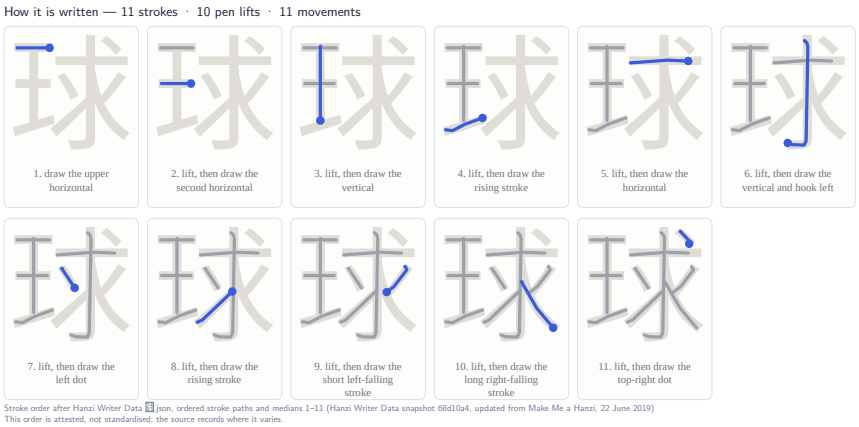
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qiúchǎng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  理 场

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lǐ*, *chǎng*

Script — the jade piece, then seven strokes



How 球 *is written, stroke by stroke*

球

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, four strokes, as on the left of 理: two bars, a vertical through them, then a stroke rising to the right.

The right piece, seven strokes. A bar. A long vertical down through it that hooks at the foot. On the left, a dot and a stroke rising to the right. On the right, a short stroke falling to the left and a long stroke falling to the right. Last, the small dot at the top right.

4 + 7 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 球, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 球 have? (**Two**.) Which character you know has the same left piece? (理.) Which stroke comes last? (**The small dot at the top right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 球, pinned stroke paths and medians.

498.4 球门 (qiúmén) — goalmouth; goal (in football)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for physical education, then the Mandarin for a sports pitch.

You'll want to know: 球门

球门 — *qiúmén* — "goalmouth; goal (in football)".

他站在球门前边 *tā zhàn zài qiúmén qiánbian* — He's standing in front of the goal.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

球门 (*qiúmén*) is built from 球 'a ball' and 门 'a gate', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says the character is made of two door leaves.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúmén*
- *Say it: qiúmén*, once more
- *Say it: tā zhàn zài qiúmén qiánbian* — He's standing in front of the goal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for physical education, then the Mandarin for a sports pitch, then say *qiúmén* again

Before you move on

What does 球门 mean? ("Goalmouth; goal (in football)".) Say it once more.

498.5 shèmén — to shoot at goal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sports pitch, then the Mandarin for the goalmouth.

You'll want to know: shèmén

shèmén — "to shoot at goal".

tā shèmén de shíhou qiúmén qiánbian méiyǒu rén — When he shot, there was nobody in front of the goal.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shèmén is built from *shè* 'to shoot' and 门 'a gate', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zyaeH* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first with the arts of archery.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shèmén*
- *Say it: shèmén*, once more
- *Say it: tā shèmén de shíhou qiúmén qiánbian méiyǒu rén* — When he shot, there was nobody in front of the goal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sports pitch, then the Mandarin for the goalmouth, then say *shèmén* again

Before you move on

What does shèmén mean? ("To shoot at goal".) Say it once more.

498.6 进球 (jìnqiú) — to score a goal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the goalmouth, then the Mandarin for to shoot at goal.

You'll want to know: 进球

进球 — *jìnqiú* — "to score a goal".

> 进球的时候我感觉很开心 *jìnqiú de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn* — When I score, I feel great.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

进球 (*jìnqiú*) is built from 进 'to go in' and 球 'a ball', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsinH* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'forward'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jìnqiú*
- *Say it: jìnqiú*, once more
- *Say it: jìnqiú de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn* — When I score, I feel great.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the goalmouth, then the Mandarin for to shoot at goal, then say *jìnqiú* again

Before you move on

What does 进球 mean? ("To score a goal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 499

The Team

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a team, its players and captain, training and passing the ball.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 499: I can talk about a team, its players and captain, training and passing the ball.*

499.1 qiúduì — a sports team (in a ball game)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to shoot at goal, then the Mandarin for to score a goal.

You'll want to know: qiúduì

qiúduì — "a sports team (in a ball game)".

> *zhè shì wǒmen xuéxiào zuì hǎo de qiúduì* — This is our school's best team.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiúduì is built from 球 'a ball' and *duì* 'a troop', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *dwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a band of people'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúduì*
- *Say it: qiúduì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒmen xuéxiào zuì hǎo de qiúduì* — This is our school's best team.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to shoot at goal, then the Mandarin for to score a goal, then say *qiúduì* again

Before you move on

What does qiúduì mean? ("A sports team (in a ball game)".) Say it once more.

499.2 qiúyuán — a player in a ball game

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to score a goal, then the Mandarin for a sports team.

You'll want to know: qiúyuán

qiúyuán — "a player in a ball game".

tā dāng le shí nián qiúyuán — He was a player for ten years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qiúyuán is built from 球 'a ball' and *yuán* 'a member', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a count of things'; the sense 'a member' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúyuán*
- *Say it: qiúyuán*, once more
- *Say it: tā dāng le shí nián qiúyuán* — He was a player for ten years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to score a goal, then the Mandarin for a sports team, then say *qiúyuán* again

Before you move on

What does qiúyuán mean? ("A player in a ball game".) Say it once more.

499.3 duìzhǎng — team captain; team leader

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a sports team, then the Mandarin for a player in a ball game.

You'll want to know: duìzhǎng

duìzhǎng — "team captain; team leader".

wǒmen dōu xiǎng dāng duìzhǎng — We all want to be captain.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duìzhǎng is built from *duì* 'a troop' and *zhǎng* 'a head', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dwojH* and *trjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'great'; the sense 'a head of a group' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: duìzhǎng*
- *Say it: duìzhǎng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen dōu xiǎng dāng duìzhǎng* — We all want to be captain.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a sports team, then the Mandarin for a player in a ball game, then say *duìzhǎng* again

Before you move on

What does duìzhǎng mean? ("Team captain; team leader".) Say it once more.

499.4 xùnliàn — to do training (for a sport); to drill

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a player in a ball game, then the Mandarin for a team captain.

You'll want to know: xùnliàn

xùnliàn — "to do training (for a sport); to drill".

wǒmen měi tiān xùnliàn liǎng ge xiǎoshí — We train for two hours a day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xùnliàn is built from *xùn* 'to instruct' and *liàn* 'to practise', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjunH* and *lenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to admonish' and the second 'white silk'; the sense 'to practise' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xùnliàn*
- *Say it: xùnliàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen měi tiān xùnliàn liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — We train for two hours a day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a player in a ball game, then the Mandarin for a team captain, then say *xùnliàn* again

Before you move on

What does xùnliàn mean? ("To do training (for a sport); to drill".) Say it once more.

499.5 传球 (chuánqiú) — to pass the ball

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a team captain, then the Mandarin for to do training (for a sport).

You'll want to know: 传球

传球 — *chuánqiú* — "to pass the ball".

他传球很快 *tā chuánqiú hěn kuài* — He passes the ball quickly.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

传球 (*chuánqiú*) is built from 传 'to hand on' and 球 'a ball', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjwen* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn'; the sense 'to pass on' it gives only under the other reading, *drjwenH*.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuánqiú*
- *Say it: chuánqiú*, once more
- *Say it: tā chuánqiú hěn kuài* — He passes the ball quickly.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a team captain, then the Mandarin for to do training (for a sport), then say *chuánqiú* again

Before you move on

What does **传球** mean? ("To pass the ball".) Say it once more.

Chapter 500

Match Day

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about winning, a match, a final, the score and taking the field.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 500: I can talk about winning, a match, a final, the score and taking the field.*

500.1 huòshèng — to win a contest; to be victorious

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to do training (for a sport), then the Mandarin for to pass the ball.

You'll want to know: huòshèng

huòshèng — "to win a contest; to be victorious".

> *wǒmen de qiúduì huòshèng le wǒ gǎnjué tèbié gāoxìng* — Our team won, and I'm over the moon.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huòshèng is built from *huò* 'to get' and *shèng* 'victory', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweak* and *syingH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to get' and the second 'victory

and defeat' and 'to overcome'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huòshèng*
- *Say it: huòshèng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de qiúduì huòshèng le wǒ gǎnjué tèbié gāoxìng* — Our team won, and I'm over the moon.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to do training (for a sport), then the Mandarin for to pass the ball, then say *huòshèng* again

Before you move on

What does huòshèng mean? ("To win a contest; to be victorious".) Say it once more.

500.2 球赛 (qiúsài) — a ball game (a football or basketball match)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pass the ball, then the Mandarin for to win a contest.

You'll want to know: 球赛

球赛 — *qiúsài* — "a ball game (a football or basketball match)".

> 这是我看过的最好的一场球赛 *zhè shì wǒ kàn guo de zuì hǎo de yì chǎng qiúsài* — This is the best match I've ever seen.

The new character, in pieces: 赛 — fourteen strokes in three pieces: the roof of 家 *jiā* on top, three strokes; in the middle seven strokes, two short bars, two verticals, a long bar and two strokes spreading left and right; at the foot four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

球赛 (*qiúsài*) is built from 球 'a ball' and 赛 'a contest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *sojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to repay'; the sense 'a contest' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúsài*
- *Say it: qiúsài*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ kàn guo de zuì hǎo de yì chǎng qiúsài* — This is the best match I've ever seen.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pass the ball, then the Mandarin for to win a contest, then say *qiúsài* again

Before you move on

What does 球赛 mean? ("A ball game (a football or basketball match)".) Say it once more.

500.3 赛 — a roof, a middle of seven strokes, a foot of four

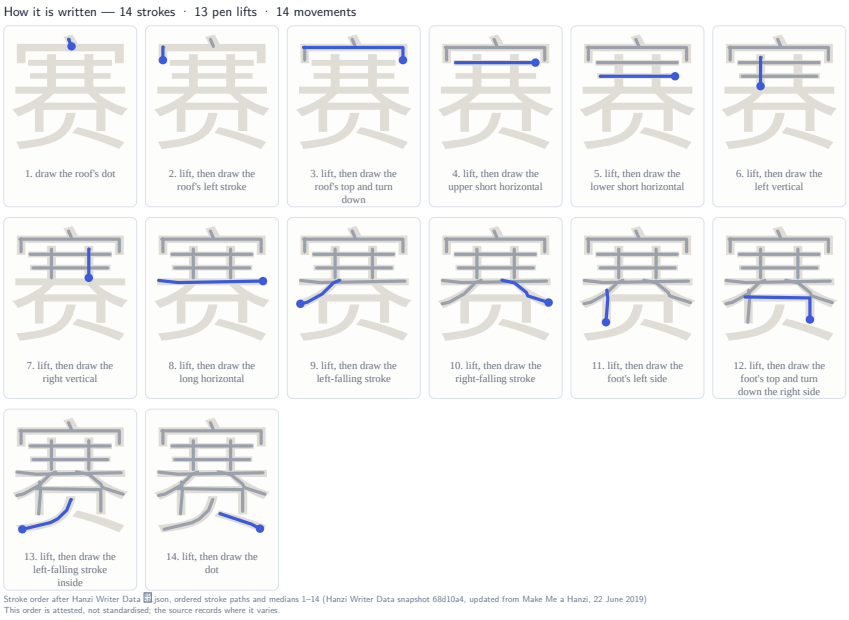
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qiúsài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  家 比

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jiā*, *bǐ*

Script — a roof, a middle of seven strokes, a foot of four



How 赛 is written, stroke by stroke

赛

Three pieces, top to bottom.

The roof, three strokes, as on top of 家 and 安: a dot, a short stroke down on the left, then a bar that turns down at the right end and hooks.

The middle, seven strokes. Two short bars, one under the other. Two verticals down through them. A long bar across. Then a stroke falling to the left and a stroke falling to the right, spreading out like legs.

The foot, four strokes: a vertical, a bar that turns down, a stroke falling to the left inside, and a dot.

3 + 7 + 4 = fourteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 赛, all fourteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 赛 have? (**Three**.) What is on top? (**The roof of 家**.) How many strokes at the foot? (**Four**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 赛, pinned stroke paths and medians.

500.4 juésài — final (of a competition)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to win a contest, then the Mandarin for a ball game.

You'll want to know: juésài

juésài — "final (of a competition)".

wǒmen de qiúduì jìn le juésài — Our team got into the final.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

juésài is built from *jué* 'to decide' and 赛 'a contest', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwet* and *sojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to cut' and 'to break through'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: juésài*
- *Say it: juésài*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de qiúduì jìn le juésài* — Our team got into the final.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to win a contest, then the Mandarin for a ball game, then say *juésài* again

Before you move on

What does juésài mean? ("Final (of a competition)".) Say it once more.

500.5 bǐfēn — the score of a game

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a ball game, then the Mandarin for final (of a competition).

You'll want to know: bǐfēn

bǐfēn — "the score of a game".

xiànzài bǐfēn shì duōshao — What's the score now?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bǐfēn is built from 比 'to compare' and *fēn* 'a part', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjijX* and *pjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to collate' and the second 'to divide'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bǐfēn*
- *Say it: bǐfēn*, once more
- *Say it: xiànzài bǐfēn shì duōshao* — What's the score now?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a ball game, then the Mandarin for final (of a competition), then say *bǐfēn* again

Before you move on

What does bǐfēn mean? ("The score of a game".) Say it once more.

500.6 上场 (shàngchǎng) — to take the field; to come on (to play)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for final (of a competition), then the Mandarin for the score of a game.

You'll want to know: 上场

上场 — *shàngchǎng* — "to take the field; to come on (to play)".

> 这场比赛我没有上场 *zhè chǎng bǐsài wǒ méiyǒu shàngchǎng* — I didn't get on the pitch in this match.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上场 (*shàngchǎng*) is built from 上 'to go up' and 场 'a ground', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *drjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to climb' and the second 'a threshing floor'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngchǎng*
- *Say it: shàngchǎng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè chǎng bǐsài wǒ méiyǒu shàngchǎng* — I didn't get on the pitch in this match.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for final (of a competition), then the Mandarin for the score of a game, then say *shàngchǎng* again

Before you move on

What does 上场 mean? ("To take the field; to come on (to play)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 501

Winners

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about athletes, champions, gold medals, winning prizes and star players.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 501: I can talk about athletes, champions, gold medals, winning prizes and star players.*

501.1 yùndòngyuán — athlete

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the score of a game, then the Mandarin for to take the field.

You'll want to know: yùndòngyuán

yùndòngyuán — "athlete".

> *wǒ xiǎoshíhou xiǎng dāng yùndòngyuán* — When I was a kid I wanted to be an athlete.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yùndòngyuán is built from *yùndòng* 'sport' and *yuán* 'a member', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjunH*, *duwngX* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to move' and the third 'a count of things'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùndòngyuán*
- *Say it: yùndòngyuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎoshíhou xiǎng dāng yùndòngyuán* — When I was a kid I wanted to be an athlete.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the score of a game, then the Mandarin for to take the field, then say *yùndòngyuán* again

Before you move on

What does yùndòngyuán mean? ("Athlete".) Say it once more.

501.2 guànjūn — champion

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to take the field, then the Mandarin for an athlete.

You'll want to know: guànjūn

guànjūn — "champion".

tā dāng guo liǎng cì guànjūn — He's been champion twice.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

guànjūn is built from *guàn* 'to put on a cap' and *jūn* 'an army', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwanH* and *kjun* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to tie on the cap' and the second 'a body of troops'. How the pair came to mean 'champion' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: guànjūn*
- *Say it: guànjūn*, once more
- *Say it: tā dāng guo liǎng cì guànjūn* — He's been champion twice.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to take the field, then the Mandarin for an athlete, then say *guànjūn* again

Before you move on

What does guànjūn mean? ("Champion".) Say it once more.

501.3 jīnpái — gold medal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an athlete, then the Mandarin for the champion.

You'll want to know: jīnpái

jīnpái — "gold medal".

tā zuì xiǎng yào yí kuài jīnpái — What he wants most is a gold medal.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīnpái is built from *jīn* 'gold' and *pái* 'a tablet', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kim* and *bea* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'gold' and the second 'a signboard'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīnpái*
- *Say it: jīnpái*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuì xiǎng yào yí kuài jīnpái* — What he wants most is a gold medal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an athlete, then the Mandarin for the champion, then say *jīnpái* again

Before you move on

What does jīnpái mean? ("Gold medal".) Say it once more.

501.4 huòdé — to win (a prize); to be awarded

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the champion, then the Mandarin for a gold medal.

You'll want to know: huòdé

huòdé — "to win (a prize); to be awarded".

tā huòdé le liǎng kuài jīnpái — She won two gold medals.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huòdé is built from *huò* 'to get' and 得 'to gain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweak* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to get' and the second 'gain and loss'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huòdé*
- *Say it: huòdé*, once more
- *Say it: tā huòdé le liǎng kuài jīnpái* — She won two gold medals.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the champion, then the Mandarin for a gold medal, then say *huòdé* again

Before you move on

What does huòdé mean? ("To win (a prize); to be awarded".) Say it once more.

501.5 球星 (qiúxīng) — star player; sports star

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a gold medal, then the Mandarin for to win (a prize).

You'll want to know: 球星

球星 — *qiúxīng* — "star player; sports star".

那个球星今天没有来比赛 *nàge qiúxīng jīntiān méiyǒu lái bǐsài* — That star player didn't come to play today.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

球星 (*qiúxīng*) is built from 球 'a ball' and 星 'a star', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gjuw* and *seng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'the stars'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiúxīng*
- *Say it: qiúxīng*, once more

- *Say it: nàge qiúxīng jīntiān méiyǒu lái bǐsài* — That star player didn't come to play today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a gold medal, then the Mandarin for to win (a prize), then say *qiúxīng* again

Before you move on

What does 球星 mean? ("Star player; sports star".) Say it once more.

Chapter 502

Painting

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about oil painting, Chinese painting, painters, famous paintings and art shows.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 502: I can talk about oil painting, Chinese painting, painters, famous paintings and art shows.*

502.1 yóuhuà — oil painting

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to win (a prize), then the Mandarin for a star player.

You'll want to know: yóuhuà

yóuhuà — "oil painting".

> *wǒ xué le liǎng nián yóuhuà* — I studied oil painting for two years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yóuhuà is built from *yóu* 'oil' and *huà* 'a painting', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuw* and *hweaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second, after an older book, 'to hang': to hang up the shapes of things in the five colours.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yóuhuà*
- *Say it: yóuhuà*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xué le liǎng nián yóuhuà* — I studied oil painting for two years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to win (a prize), then the Mandarin for a star player, then say *yóuhuà* again

Before you move on

What does yóuhuà mean? ("Oil painting".) Say it once more.

502.2 国画 (guóhuà) — traditional Chinese painting

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a star player, then the Mandarin for an oil painting.

You'll want to know: 国画

国画 — *guóhuà* — "traditional Chinese painting".

wǒ juéde guóhuà bǐ yóuhuà yǒuyìsi — I find Chinese painting more interesting than oil painting.

The new character, in pieces: 画 — eight strokes: a bar on top, then five strokes as on top of 男 *nán*, then an open box of two strokes around them. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

国画 (*guóhuà*) is built from 国 'a country' and 画 'a painting', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *hweaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a state'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: guóhuà*
- *Say it: guóhuà*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde guóhuà bǐ yóuhuà yǒuyìsi* — I find Chinese painting more interesting than oil painting.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a star player, then the Mandarin for an oil painting, then say *guóhuà* again

Before you move on

What does 国画 mean? ("Traditional Chinese painting".) Say it once more.

502.3 画 — a bar, a field, an open box

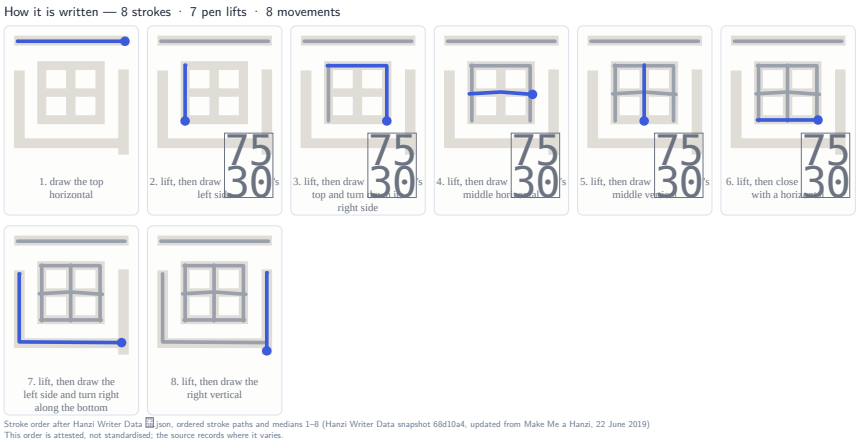
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *guóhuà* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  男 国

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nán*, *guó*

Script — a bar, a field, an open box



How 画 is written, stroke by stroke

画

A bar on top.

Then five strokes, as on top of 男: a vertical, a bar that turns down, a middle bar, a middle vertical, and the bottom bar.

Then the open box, two strokes: one that runs down the left and turns right along the bottom, and last a vertical on the right, from top to bottom.

1 + 5 + 2 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 画, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 画 have? (**Eight**.) What sits in the middle? (**The top of 男**.) Which stroke is last? (**The vertical on the right**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 画, pinned stroke paths and medians.

502.4 画家 (huàjiā) — painter (an artist)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an oil painting, then the Mandarin for a traditional Chinese painting.

You'll want to know: 画家

画家 — *huàjiā* — "painter (an artist)".

小时候我想当画家 *xiǎoshíhou wǒ xiǎng dāng huàjiā* — When I was little I wanted to be a painter.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

画家 (*huàjiā*) is built from 画 'a painting' and 家 'a household', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweaH* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a dwelling'; the sense 'a master of an art' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàjiā*
- *Say it: huàjiā*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou wǒ xiǎng dāng huàjiā* — When I was little I wanted to be a painter.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an oil painting, then the Mandarin for a traditional Chinese painting, then say *huàjiā* again

Before you move on

What does 画家 mean? ("Painter (an artist)".) Say it once more.

502.5 名画 (mínghuà) — famous painting

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a traditional Chinese painting, then the Mandarin for a painter (an artist).

You'll want to know: 名画

名画 — *mínghuà* — "famous painting".

> 这些名画我都看过 *zhèxiē mínghuà wǒ dōu kàn guo* — I've seen all these famous paintings.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

名画 (*mínghuà*) is built from 名 'a name' and 画 'a painting', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjieng* and *hweaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a name' and 'a title'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mínghuà*
- *Say it: mínghuà*, once more
- *Say it: zhèxiē mínghuà wǒ dōu kàn guo* — I've seen all these famous paintings.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a traditional Chinese painting, then the Mandarin for a painter (an artist), then say *mínghuà* again

Before you move on

What does 名画 mean? ("Famous painting".) Say it once more.

502.6 huàzhǎn — art exhibition

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a painter (an artist), then the Mandarin for a famous painting.

You'll want to know: huàzhǎn

huàzhǎn — "art exhibition".

xīngqīliù wǒmen qù kàn huàzhǎn — We're going to an art exhibition on Saturday.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huàzhǎn is built from 画 'a painting' and *zhǎn* 'to unfold', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hweaH* and *trjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to spread out'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huàzhǎn*
- *Say it: huàzhǎn*, once more
- *Say it: xīngqīliù wǒmen qù kàn huàzhǎn* — We're going to an art exhibition on Saturday.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a painter (an artist), then the Mandarin for a famous painting, then say *huàzhǎn* again

Before you move on

What does huàzhǎn mean? ("Art exhibition".) Say it once more.

Chapter 503

Art

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about calligraphy, the arts, a work of art, creating one and new year prints.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 503: I can talk about calligraphy, the arts, a work of art, creating one and new year prints.*

503.1 书法 (shūfǎ) — calligraphy

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a famous painting, then the Mandarin for an art exhibition.

You'll want to know: 书法

书法 — *shūfǎ* — "calligraphy".

> *wǒ yéye xué le shí nián shūfǎ* — My grandpa studied calligraphy for ten years.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

书法 (*shūfǎ*) is built from 书 'writing' and 法 'a rule', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syo* and *pjop* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a rule' and 'a norm'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shūfǎ*
- *Say it: shūfǎ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yéye xué le shí nián shūfǎ* — My grandpa studied calligraphy for ten years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a famous painting, then the Mandarin for an art exhibition, then say *shūfǎ* again

Before you move on

What does 书法 mean? (“Calligraphy”.) Say it once more.

503.2 yìshù — art; the arts

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an art exhibition, then the Mandarin for calligraphy.

You’ll want to know: yìshù

yìshù — “art; the arts”.

tā zuì xǐhuan yìshù — Art is what she loves most.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yìshù is built from *yì* ’a skill’ and *shù* ’a technique’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjiejH* and *zywit* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’ability’ and the second ’technique’.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yìshù*
- *Say it: yìshù*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuì xǐhuan yìshù* — Art is what she loves most.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an art exhibition, then the Mandarin for calligraphy, then say *yìshù* again

Before you move on

What does yìshù mean? ("Art; the arts".) Say it once more.

503.3 zuòpǐn — a work of art; a piece of writing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for calligraphy, then the Mandarin for the arts.

You'll want to know: zuòpǐn

zuòpǐn — "a work of art; a piece of writing".

zhè shì tā zuì hǎo de zuòpǐn — This is his best work.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zuòpǐn is built from 作 'to make' and *pǐn* 'a kind', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsak* and *phimX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a rank' and 'a kind'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zuòpǐn*
- *Say it: zuòpǐn*, once more

- *Say it: zhè shì tā zuì hǎo de zuòpǐn* — This is his best work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for calligraphy, then the Mandarin for the arts, then say *zuòpǐn* again

Before you move on

What does zuòpǐn mean? ("A work of art; a piece of writing".) Say it once more.

503.4 chuàngzuò — to create (art or writing)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the arts, then the Mandarin for a work of art.

You'll want to know: chuàngzuò

chuàngzuò — "to create (art or writing)".

tā yòng le wǔ nián chuàngzuò zhège zuòpǐn — He spent five years creating this work.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuàngzuò is built from *chuàng* 'to found' and 作 'to make', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhjangH* and *tsak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the level-tone reading 'a wound', and gives the falling-tone one as another spelling of a word glossed 'to begin' and 'to found a craft'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuàngzuò*
- *Say it: chuàngzuò*, once more

- *Say it: tā yòng le wǔ nián chuàngzuò zhège zuòpǐn* — He spent five years creating this work.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the arts, then the Mandarin for a work of art, then say *chuàngzuò* again

Before you move on

What does chuàngzuò mean? ("To create (art or writing)".) Say it once more.

503.5 年画 (niánhuà) — a new year print (hung at the spring festival)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a work of art, then the Mandarin for to create (art or writing).

You'll want to know: 年画

年画 — *niánhuà* — "a new year print (hung at the spring festival)".

guònián de shíhou wǒ nǎinai mǎi le yìxiē niánhuà — At the new year, my grandma bought some new year prints.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

年画 (*niánhuà*) is built from 年 'a year' and 画 'a painting', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nen* and *hweaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the grain is ripe'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: niánhuà*
- *Say it: niánhuà*, once more
- *Say it: guònián de shíhou wǒ nǎinai mǎi le yìxiē niánhuà* — At the new year, my grandma bought some new year prints.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a work of art, then the Mandarin for to create (art or writing), then say *niánhuà* again

Before you move on

What does 年画 mean? ("A new year print (hung at the spring festival)".) Say it once more.

503.6 Looking back: from On the Pitch to Art

Say the Mandarin for physical education and a sports pitch.

Your turn

- *Say it:* physical education, a sports pitch, the goalmouth, to shoot at goal, to score a goal
- *Say it:* a sports team, a player in a ball game, a team captain, to do training (for a sport), to pass the ball
- *Say it:* to win a contest, a ball game, final (of a competition), the score of a game, to take the field
- *Say it:* an athlete, the champion, a gold medal, to win (a prize), a star player
- *Say it:* an oil painting, a traditional Chinese painting, a painter (an artist), a famous painting, an art exhibition
- *Say it:* calligraphy, the arts, a work of art, to create (art or writing), a new year print
- *Read it:* 球 赛 画 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

Physical education? (*tǐyù.*) A sports pitch? (球场, *qiúchǎng.*) The goalmouth? (球门, *qiúmén.*) To shoot at goal? (*shèmén.*) To score a goal? (进球, *jìnqiú.*) A sports team? (*qiúduì.*) A player in a ball game? (*qiúyuán.*) A team captain? (*duìzhǎng.*) To do training (for a sport)? (*xùnliàn.*) To pass the ball? (传球, *chuánqiú.*) To win a

contest? (*huòshèng.*) A ball game? (球赛, *qiúsài.*) Final (of a competition)? (*juésài.*) The score of a game? (*bǐfēn.*) To take the field? (上场, *shàngchǎng.*) An athlete? (*yùndòngyuán.*) The champion? (*guànjūn.*) A gold medal? (*jīnpái.*) To win (a prize)? (*huòdé.*) A star player? (球星, *qiúxīng.*) An oil painting? (*yóuhuà.*) A traditional Chinese painting? (国画, *guóhuà.*) A painter (an artist)? (画家, *huàjiā.*) A famous painting? (名画, *mínghuà.*) An art exhibition? (*huàzhǎn.*) Calligraphy? (书法, *shūfǎ.*) The arts? (*yìshù.*) A work of art? (*zuòpǐn.*) To create (art or writing)? (*chuàngzuò.*) A new year print? (年画, *niánhuà.*)

Chapter 504

Songs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the words of a song, nursery rhymes, the national anthem, folk songs and singing on stage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 504: I can talk about the words of a song, nursery rhymes, the national anthem, folk songs and singing on stage.*

504.1 gēcí — the words of a song; lyrics

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to create (art or writing), then the Mandarin for a new year print.

You'll want to know: gēcí

gēcí — "the words of a song; lyrics".

> *wǒ tīng le liǎng tiān cái jìzhù gēcí* — It took two days of listening before I knew the words.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēcí is built from *gē* 'a song' and *cí* 'words', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ka* and *zi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the voice of a person singing' and the second 'to speak'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēcí*
- *Say it: gēcí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ tīng le liǎng tiān cái jìzhù gēcí* — It took two days of listening before I knew the words.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to create (art or writing), then the Mandarin for a new year print, then say *gēcí* again

Before you move on

What does gēcí mean? ("The words of a song; lyrics".) Say it once more.

504.2 儿歌 (érgē) — nursery rhyme; children's song

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a new year print, then the Mandarin for the words of a song.

You'll want to know: 儿歌

儿歌 — *érgē* — "nursery rhyme; children's song".

这是我小时候最喜欢的儿歌 *zhè shì wǒ xiǎoshíhou zuì xǐhuan de érgē* — This was my favourite nursery rhyme when I was little.

The new character, in pieces: 歌 — fourteen strokes in two pieces: on the left 可 *kě* twice, one over the other, ten strokes; on the right four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

儿歌 (*érgē*) is built from 儿 'a child' and 歌 'a song', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nye* and *ka* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'an infant' and the second 'the voice of a person singing'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: érgē*
- *Say it: érgē*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ xiǎoshíhou zuì xǐhuan de érgē* — This was my favourite nursery rhyme when I was little.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a new year print, then the Mandarin for the words of a song, then say *érgē* again

Before you move on

What does 儿歌 mean? ("Nursery rhyme; children's song".) Say it once more.

504.3 歌 — kě twice, then four strokes

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *érgē* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

可 儿

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kě*, *ér*

Script — kě twice, then four strokes

How 歌 *is written, stroke by stroke*

歌

Two pieces, left before right.

The left piece, ten strokes: 可 *kě* twice, one over the other. The upper 可 is small: a bar, 口, and a vertical with no hook. The lower 可 is wider: a long bar, 口, and a vertical that hooks to the left.

The right piece, four strokes: a short stroke falling to the left, a bar that turns down to the left, a long stroke falling to the left, and a long stroke falling to the right.

5 + 5 + 4 = fourteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 歌, all fourteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 歌 have? (**Fourteen.**) What is the left piece? (**可, twice.**) Which of the two has a hook? (**The lower one.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 歌, pinned stroke paths and medians.

504.4 国歌 (guógē) — national anthem

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the words of a song, then the Mandarin for a nursery rhyme.

You'll want to know: 国歌

国歌 — *guógē* — "national anthem".

tīng guógē de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn jīdòng — When I hear the national anthem, I feel very moved.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

国歌 (*guógē*) is built from 国 'a country' and 歌 'a song', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwok* and *ka* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: guógē*
- *Say it: guógē*, once more
- *Say it: tīng guógē de shíhou wǒ gǎnjué hěn jīdòng* — When I hear the national anthem, I feel very moved.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the words of a song, then the Mandarin for a nursery rhyme, then say *guógē* again

Before you move on

What does 国歌 mean? ("National anthem".) Say it once more.

504.5 míngē — folk song

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a nursery rhyme, then the Mandarin for the national anthem.

You'll want to know: míngē

míngē — "folk song".

wǒ zuì xǐhuan tīng Zhōngguó míngē — Chinese folk songs are my favourite.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

míngē is built from *mín* 'the people' and 歌 'a song', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjin* and *ka* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'the common people'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngē*
- *Say it: míngē*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì xǐhuan tīng Zhōngguó míngē* — Chinese folk songs are my favourite.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a nursery rhyme, then the Mandarin for the national anthem, then say *míngē* again

Before you move on

What does míngē mean? ("Folk song".) Say it once more.

504.6 yǎnchàng — to perform a song (on stage)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the national anthem, then the Mandarin for a folk song.

You'll want to know: yǎnchàng

yǎnchàng — "to perform a song (on stage)".

nàge gēshǒu lái wǒmen xuéxiào yǎnchàng — That singer is coming to sing at our school.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎnchàng is built from *yǎn* 'to perform' and *chàng* 'to sing', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yenX* and *tsyhangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to spread wide' and the second 'to strike up a song'; the sense 'to perform' is not given for the first there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnchàng*
- *Say it: yǎnchàng*, once more
- *Say it: nàge gēshǒu lái wǒmen xuéxiào yǎnchàng* — That singer is coming to sing at our school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the national anthem, then the Mandarin for a folk song, then say *yǎnchàng* again

Before you move on

What does yǎnchàng mean? ("To perform a song (on stage)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 505

Dancing

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about dance, a dance party, a dance partner, the stage and rehearsals.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 505: I can talk about dance, a dance party, a dance partner, the stage and rehearsals.*

505.1 wǔdǎo — the art of dance

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a folk song, then the Mandarin for to perform a song (on stage).

You'll want to know: wǔdǎo

wǔdǎo — "the art of dance".

> *wǒ nǚ'ér xué le wǔ nián wǔdǎo* — My daughter has studied dance for five years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: wǔ is said with a rising tone before dǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǔdǎo is built from *wǔ* 'to dance' and *dǎo* 'to tread', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjuX* and *dawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'singing and dancing' and the second 'to tread'. The modern third tone of dǎo is irregular: *dawH* would regularly give dào.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǔdǎo*
- *Say it: wǔdǎo*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nǚ'ér xué le wǔ nián wǔdǎo* — My daughter has studied dance for five years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a folk song, then the Mandarin for to perform a song (on stage), then say *wǔdǎo* again

Before you move on

What does wǔdǎo mean? ("The art of dance".) Say it once more.

505.2 舞会 (wǔhuì) — dance party; ball

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to perform a song (on stage), then the Mandarin for the art of dance.

You'll want to know: 舞会

舞会 — *wǔhuì* — "dance party; ball".

zhè shì wǒ dìyī cì cānjiā wǔhuì — This is the first time I've been to a dance.

The new character, in pieces: 舞 — fourteen strokes: on top eight, a short stroke falling left, two bars with four short verticals through the lower one, and a long bar across; below, on the left the top of 多 *duō*, three strokes, and on the right three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

舞会 (*wǔhuì*) is built from 舞 'to dance' and 会 'a gathering', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjuX* and *hwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'singing and dancing' and the second 'to meet'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǔhuì*
- *Say it: wǔhuì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì wǒ dìyī cì cānjiā wǔhuì* — This is the first time I've been to a dance.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to perform a song (on stage), then the Mandarin for the art of dance, then say *wǔhuì* again

Before you move on

What does 舞会 mean? ("Dance party; ball".) Say it once more.

505.3 舞 — eight strokes on top, then two pieces below

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *wǔhuì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  多 会

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *duō*, *huì*

Script — eight strokes on top, then two pieces below

How 舞 is written, stroke by stroke

舞

The top, eight strokes. A short stroke falling to the left. A short bar, then a longer bar under it. Four short verticals through it, from left to right. Then a long bar across the whole width.

The lower left, three strokes, as on top of 多: a stroke falling to the left, a bar that turns and falls to the left, and a dot.

The lower right, three strokes: a bar, a stroke that drops and turns to the right, then a long vertical down through them.

8 + 3 + 3 = fourteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 舞, all fourteen, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 舞 have? (**Fourteen**.) How many short verticals in the top? (**Four**.) Which character you know has the lower left piece on top? (多.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 舞, pinned stroke paths and medians.

505.4 wǔbàn — dance partner

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the art of dance, then the Mandarin for a dance party.

You'll want to know: wǔbàn

wǔbàn — "dance partner".

tā shì wǒ zuì hǎo de wǔbàn — She's my best dance partner.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǔbàn is built from 舞 'to dance' and *bàn* 'a companion', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjuX* and *banX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a companion'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǔbàn*
- *Say it: wǔbàn*, once more
- *Say it: tā shì wǒ zuì hǎo de wǔbàn* — She's my best dance partner.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the art of dance, then the Mandarin for a dance party, then say *wǔbàn* again

Before you move on

What does wǔbàn mean? (“Dance partner”.) Say it once more.

505.5 wǔtái — stage (in a theatre)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a dance party, then the Mandarin for a dance partner.

You’ll want to know: wǔtái

wǔtái — “stage (in a theatre)”.

nàge wǔtái bǐ wǒmen xuéxiào de dà — That stage is bigger than our school’s.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wǔtái is built from 舞 ’to dance’ and *tái* ’a platform’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjuX* and *doj* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the second as a raised square of earth.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wǔtái*
- *Say it: wǔtái*, once more
- *Say it: nàge wǔtái bǐ wǒmen xuéxiào de dà* — That stage is bigger than our school’s.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a dance party, then the Mandarin for a dance partner, then say *wǔtái* again

Before you move on

What does wǔtái mean? (“Stage (in a theatre)”.) Say it once more.

505.6 páiliàn — to rehearse

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a dance partner, then the Mandarin for a stage (in a theatre).

You’ll want to know: páiliàn

páiliàn — “to rehearse”.

wǒmen páiliàn le yí ge yuè — We rehearsed for a month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

páiliàn is built from *pái* ’to line up’ and *liàn* ’to practise’, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *beaj* and *lenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter’s transcription), which glosses the first ’to push’ and the second ’white silk’; the senses ’to line up’ and ’to practise’ are not given there.

What you’ve built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: páiliàn*
- *Say it: páiliàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen páiliàn le yí ge yuè* — We rehearsed for a month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a dance partner, then the Mandarin for a stage (in a theatre), then say *páiliàn* again

Before you move on

What does páiliàn mean? (“To rehearse”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 506

Music on Stage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a band, performing on an instrument, the violin, Beijing opera and fans.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 506: I can talk about a band, performing on an instrument, the violin, Beijing opera and fans.*

506.1 yuèduì — band (of musicians)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a stage (in a theatre), then the Mandarin for to rehearse.

You'll want to know: yuèduì

yuèduì — "band (of musicians)".

> *wǒ zài yuèduì tán le sān nián jítā* — I played guitar in a band for three years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuèduì is built from 乐 'music' and *duì* 'a troop', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngaewk* and *dwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'music' and the second 'a band of people'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuèduì*
- *Say it: yuèduì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài yuèduì tán le sān nián jítā* — I played guitar in a band for three years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a stage (in a theatre), then the Mandarin for to rehearse, then say *yuèduì* again

Before you move on

What does yuèduì mean? ("Band (of musicians)".) Say it once more.

506.2 yǎnzòu — to perform on an instrument

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to rehearse, then the Mandarin for a band (of musicians).

You'll want to know: yǎnzòu

yǎnzòu — "to perform on an instrument".

tā yǎnzòu de hěn hǎo — He plays beautifully.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yǎnzòu is built from *yǎn* 'to perform' and *zòu* 'to present', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yenX* and *tsuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to spread wide' and the second 'to offer up'; the sense 'to play music' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǎnzòu*
- *Say it: yǎnzòu*, once more
- *Say it: tā yǎnzòu de hěn hǎo* — He plays beautifully.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to rehearse, then the Mandarin for a band (of musicians), then say *yǎnzòu* again

Before you move on

What does yǎnzòu mean? ("To perform on an instrument".) Say it once more.

506.3 xiǎotíqín — violin

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a band (of musicians), then the Mandarin for to perform on an instrument.

You'll want to know: xiǎotíqín

xiǎotíqín — "violin".

wǒ xué le bā nián xiǎotíqín — I've been learning the violin for eight years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiǎotíqín is built from 小 'small', *tí* 'to lift' and *qín* 'a zither', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjewX*, *dej* and *gim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to carry by hand' and the third as a stringed instrument; the name for the violin is modern.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiǎotíqín*
- *Say it: xiǎotíqín*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xué le bā nián xiǎotíqín* — I've been learning the violin for eight years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a band (of musicians), then the Mandarin for to perform on an instrument, then say *xiǎotíqín* again

Before you move on

What does xiǎotíqín mean? ("Violin".) Say it once more.

506.4 Jīngjù — Beijing opera

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to perform on an instrument, then the Mandarin for a violin.

You'll want to know: Jīngjù

Jīngjù — "Beijing opera".

nǐ kàn guo Jīngjù ma — Have you ever seen Beijing opera?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

Jīngjù is built from *Jīng*, short for the capital Beijing, and *jù* 'a play', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kjaeng* and *gjaek* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'great' and the second 'to increase' and 'hard'; the sense 'a play' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: Jīngjù*
- *Say it: Jīngjù*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ kàn guo Jīngjù ma* — Have you ever seen Beijing opera?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to perform on an instrument, then the Mandarin for a violin, then say *Jīngjù* again

Before you move on

What does Jīngjù mean? ("Beijing opera".) Say it once more.

506.5 gēmí — fan (of a singer)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a violin, then the Mandarin for Beijing opera.

You'll want to know: gēmí

gēmí — "fan (of a singer)".

wǒ shì nàge gēshǒu zuì dà de gēmí — I'm that singer's biggest fan.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēmí is built from 歌 'a song' and *mí* 'to be led astray', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ka* and *mej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to be confused'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēmí*
- *Say it: gēmí*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shì nàge gēshǒu zuì dà de gēmí* — I'm that singer's biggest fan.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a violin, then the Mandarin for Beijing opera, then say *gēmí* again

Before you move on

What does gēmí mean? ("Fan (of a singer)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 507

Fathers and Sons

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about brothers, fathers and sons, fathers and daughters, married couples and my elders.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 507: I can talk about brothers, fathers and sons, fathers and daughters, married couples and my elders.*

507.1 xiōngdì — brothers

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for Beijing opera, then the Mandarin for a fan (of a singer).

You'll want to know: xiōngdì

xiōngdì — "brothers".

> *xiōngdì liǎng ge gēge bǐ dìdi gāo* — Of the two brothers, the elder is taller.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiōngdì is built from *xiōng* 'an elder brother' and *dì* 'a younger brother', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjwaeng* and *dejX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, 'a man born first' and the second 'a man born after'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiōngdì*
- *Say it: xiōngdì*, once more
- *Say it: xiōngdì liǎng ge gēge bǐ dìdi gāo* — Of the two brothers, the elder is taller.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for Beijing opera, then the Mandarin for a fan (of a singer), then say *xiōngdì* again

Before you move on

What does xiōngdì mean? ("Brothers".) Say it once more.

507.2 父子 (fùzǐ) — father and son

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a fan (of a singer), then the Mandarin for brothers.

You'll want to know: 父子

父子 — *fùzǐ* — "father and son".

他们父子都是歌手 *tāmen fùzǐ dōu shì gēshǒu* — Father and son are both singers.

The new character, in pieces: 父 — four strokes: two short strokes on top, one falling left and a dot falling right, then two long strokes that cross, one falling left and one falling right. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

父子 (*fùzǐ*) is built from 父 'a father' and 子 'a son', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuX* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, as the head of a family who leads and teaches, and the second 'offspring'. The

dictionary also lists 父 as *pjuX*, a title of respect for a man.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùzǐ*
- *Say it: fùzǐ*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen fùzǐ dōu shì gēshǒu* — Father and son are both singers.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a fan (of a singer), then the Mandarin for brothers, then say *fùzǐ* again

Before you move on

What does 父子 mean? ("Father and son".) Say it once more.

507.3 父 — two short strokes, then two long ones

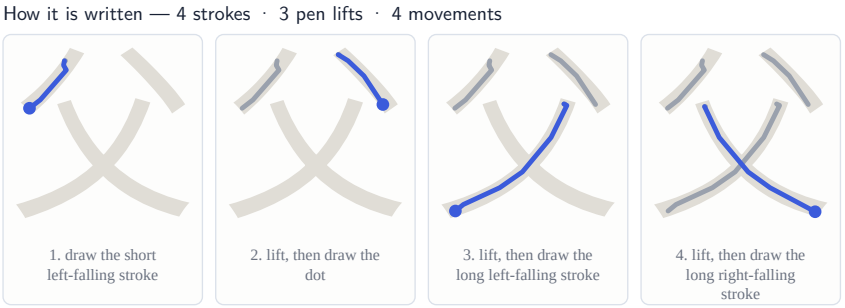
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *fùzǐ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  人 子

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *rén*, *zǐ*

Script — two short strokes, then two long ones



How 父 is written, stroke by stroke

父

Two short strokes on top: on the left a stroke falling to the left, on the right a dot falling to the right.

Then two long strokes that cross: a long stroke falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the right, like the legs of 人 set wide.

2 + 2 = four.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 父, all four, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 父 have? (**Four**.) Which way does the first stroke fall? (**To the left**.) What do the last two strokes do? (**They cross**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 父, pinned stroke paths and medians.

507.4 父女 (fùnǚ) — father and daughter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for brothers, then the Mandarin for a father and son.

You'll want to know: 父女

父女 — *fùnǚ* — "father and daughter".

> 他们父女一起去了舞会 *tāmen fùnǚ yìqǐ qù le wǔhuì* — Father and daughter went to the dance together.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

父女 (*fùnǚ*) is built from 父 'a father' and 女 'a daughter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuX* and *nrjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùnǚ*
- *Say it: fùnǚ*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen fùnǚ yìqǐ qù le wǔhuì* — Father and daughter went to the dance together.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for brothers, then the Mandarin for a father and son, then say *fùnǚ* again

Before you move on

What does 父女 mean? ("Father and daughter".) Say it once more.

507.5 fūqī — married couple; husband and wife

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a father and son, then the Mandarin for a father and daughter.

You'll want to know: fūqī

fūqī — "married couple; husband and wife".

tāmen zuò le sìshí nián fūqī — They've been married for forty years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fūqī is built from *fū* 'a grown man' and *qī* 'a wife', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pju* and *tshej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a grown man' and the second with a word of like sound meaning 'level'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fūqī*
- *Say it: fūqī*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen zuò le sìshí nián fūqī* — They've been married for forty years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a father and son, then the Mandarin for a father and daughter, then say *fūqī* again

Before you move on

What does fūqī mean? ("Married couple; husband and wife".) Say it once more.

507.6 zhǎngbèi — one's elders; the older generation

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a father and daughter, then the Mandarin for a married couple.

You'll want to know: zhǎngbèi

zhǎngbèi — "one's elders; the older generation".

> *zài zhǎngbèi miànqián wǒ gǎnjué hěn jǐnzhāng* — I feel nervous in front of my elders.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǎngbèi is built from *zhǎng* 'elder' and *bèi* 'a generation', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjangX* and *pwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'great' and the second 'people of one rank'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǎngbèi*
- *Say it: zhǎngbèi*, once more
- *Say it: zài zhǎngbèi miànqián wǒ gǎnjué hěn jǐnzhāng* — I feel nervous in front of my elders.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a father and daughter, then the Mandarin for a married couple, then say *zhǎngbèi* again

Before you move on

What does zhǎngbèi mean? ("One's elders; the older generation".) Say it once more.

Chapter 508

Brothers and Sisters

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about sisters, a brother and sister, only children, being picked on and growing up sensible.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 508: I can talk about sisters, a brother and sister, only children, being picked on and growing up sensible.*

508.1 jiěmèi — sisters

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a married couple, then the Mandarin for one's elders.

You'll want to know: jiěmèi

jiěmèi — "sisters".

> *wǒmen jiěmèi sān ge wǒ zuì xiǎo* — There are three of us sisters, and I'm the youngest.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiěmèi is built from *jiě* 'an elder sister' and *mèi* 'a younger sister', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjaeX* and *mwojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a word for mother among a people of the west and the second 'a younger sister'; the sense

'elder sister' is not given for the first there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiěmèi*
- *Say it: jiěmèi*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiěmèi sān ge wǒ zuì xiǎo* — There are three of us sisters, and I'm the youngest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a married couple, then the Mandarin for one's elders, then say *jiěmèi* again

Before you move on

What does jiěmèi mean? ("Sisters".) Say it once more.

508.2 xiōngmèi — elder brother and younger sister

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's elders, then the Mandarin for sisters.

You'll want to know: xiōngmèi

xiōngmèi — "elder brother and younger sister".

tāmen xiōngmèi dōu shì dàxuésheng — The brother and sister are both at university.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiōngmèi is built from *xiōng* 'an elder brother' and *mèi* 'a younger sister', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjwaeng* and *mwojH*

(Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiōngmèi*
- *Say it: xiōngmèi*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen xiōngmèi dōu shì dàxuésheng* — The brother and sister are both at university.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's elders, then the Mandarin for sisters, then say *xiōngmèi* again

Before you move on

What does xiōngmèi mean? ("Elder brother and younger sister".) Say it once more.

508.3 dúshēngzǐnǚ — only child

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sisters, then the Mandarin for elder brother and younger sister.

You'll want to know: dúshēngzǐnǚ

dúshēngzǐnǚ — "only child".

wǒ shì dúshēngzǐnǚ xiǎoshíhou zuì xiǎng yào yí ge dìdi — I'm an only child; when I was little, what I wanted most was a little brother.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: zǐ is said with a rising tone before nǚ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dúshēngzǐnǚ is built from *dú* 'alone', 生 'to be born' and 子女 'sons and daughters', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *duwk*, *srjaeng*, *tsiX* and *nrjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). For *duwk* the dictionary quotes an older one that sets it against *qún* 'in flocks', the way sheep go.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dúshēngzǐnǚ*
- *Say it: dúshēngzǐnǚ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shì dúshēngzǐnǚ xiǎoshíhou zuì xiǎng yào yí ge dìdi* — I'm an only child; when I was little, what I wanted most was a little brother.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sisters, then the Mandarin for elder brother and younger sister, then say *dúshēngzǐnǚ* again

Before you move on

What does dúshēngzǐnǚ mean? ("Only child".) Say it once more.

508.4 qīfu — to bully; to pick on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for elder brother and younger sister, then the Mandarin for an only child.

You'll want to know: qīfu

qīfu — "to bully; to pick on".

xiǎoshíhou gēge chángcháng qīfu wǒ — When I was little, my elder brother often picked on me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīfu is built from *qī* 'to deceive' and *fù* 'to bear', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khi* and *bjuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to deceive' and the second 'to carry' and 'to repay kindness with ingratitude'; in the word the second syllable is light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīfu*
- *Say it: qīfu*, once more
- *Say it: xiǎoshíhou gēge chángcháng qīfu wǒ* — When I was little, my elder brother often picked on me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for elder brother and younger sister, then the Mandarin for an only child, then say *qīfu* again

Before you move on

What does qīfu mean? ("To bully; to pick on".) Say it once more.

508.5 dǒngshì — sensible; grown-up for one's age (of a child)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for an only child, then the Mandarin for to pick on (someone weaker).

You'll want to know: dǒngshì

dǒngshì — "sensible; grown-up for one's age (of a child)".

jiějie bǐ wǒ dǒngshì — My big sister is more grown-up than me.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǒngshì is built from *dǒng* 'to understand' and 事 'a matter'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to employ'; the Guangyun has no entry for the first, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǒngshì*
- *Say it: dǒngshì*, once more
- *Say it: jiějie bǐ wǒ dǒngshì* — My big sister is more grown-up than me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for an only child, then the Mandarin for to pick on (someone weaker), then say *dǒngshì* again

Before you move on

What does dǒngshì mean? ("Sensible; grown-up for one's age (of a child)".) Say it once more.

508.6 Looking back: from Songs to Brothers and Sisters

Say the Mandarin for the words of a song and a nursery rhyme.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the words of a song, a nursery rhyme, the national anthem, a folk song, to perform a song (on stage)
- *Say it:* the art of dance, a dance party, a dance partner, a stage (in a theatre), to rehearse

- *Say it:* a band (of musicians), to perform on an instrument, a violin, Beijing opera, a fan (of a singer)
- *Say it:* brothers, a father and son, a father and daughter, a married couple, one's elders
- *Say it:* sisters, elder brother and younger sister, an only child, to pick on (someone weaker), sensible (of a child)
- *Read it:* 歌 舞 父 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

The words of a song? (*gēcí.*) A nursery rhyme? (儿歌, *érgē.*) The national anthem? (国歌, *guógē.*) A folk song? (*míngē.*) To perform a song (on stage)? (*yǎnchàng.*) The art of dance? (*wǔdǎo.*) A dance party? (舞会, *wǔhuì.*) A dance partner? (*wǔbàn.*) A stage (in a theatre)? (*wǔtái.*) To rehearse? (*páiliàn.*) A band (of musicians)? (*yuèduì.*) To perform on an instrument? (*yǎnzòu.*) A violin? (*xiǎotíqín.*) Beijing opera? (*Jīngjù.*) A fan (of a singer)? (*gēmí.*) Brothers? (*xiōngdì.*) A father and son? (父子, *fùzǐ.*) A father and daughter? (父女, *fùnǚ.*) A married couple? (*fūqī.*) One's elders? (*zhǎngbèi.*) Sisters? (*jiěmèi.*) Elder brother and younger sister? (*xiōngmèi.*) An only child? (*dúshēngzǐnǚ.*) To pick on (someone weaker)? (*qīfu.*) Sensible (of a child)? (*dǒngshì.*)

Chapter 509

Parents

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about who runs the household, my parents, mothers and daughters, my mother tongue and stepmothers.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 509: I can talk about who runs the household, my parents, mothers and daughters, my mother tongue and stepmothers.*

509.1 当家 (dāngjiā) — to run the household

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pick on (someone weaker), then the Mandarin for sensible (of a child).

You'll want to know: 当家

当家 — *dāngjiā* — "to run the household".

> 我们家是我妈妈当家 *wǒmen jiā shì wǒ māma dāngjiā* — In our family, it's my mum who runs things.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

当家 (*dāngjiā*) is built from 当 'to be in charge' and 家 'a home', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tang* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to be in charge' and the second 'a dwelling'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāngjiā*
- *Say it: dāngjiā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiā shì wǒ māma dāngjiā* — In our family, it's my mum who runs things.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pick on (someone weaker), then the Mandarin for sensible (of a child), then say *dāngjiā* again

Before you move on

What does 当家 mean? ("To run the household".) Say it once more.

509.2 父母 (fùmǔ) — parents; one's mother and father

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sensible (of a child), then the Mandarin for to run the household.

You'll want to know: 父母

父母 — *fùmǔ* — "parents; one's mother and father".

wǒ gēn fùmǔ zhù le èrshí nián — I lived with my parents for twenty years.

The new character, in pieces: 母 — five strokes: a frame of two, one down the left that turns right along the bottom and one along the top that turns down the right side and hooks; a dot inside the top half; a long bar across; a dot inside the bottom half. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

父母 (*fùmǔ*) is built from 父 'a father' and 母 'a mother', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuX* and *muwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a mother' and, after an older book, reads its two dots as a picture of a nursing mother's breasts.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùmǔ*
- *Say it: fùmǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēn fùmǔ zhù le èrshí nián* — I lived with my parents for twenty years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sensible (of a child), then the Mandarin for to run the household, then say *fùmǔ* again

Before you move on

What does 父母 mean? ("Parents; one's mother and father".) Say it once more.

509.3 母 — a frame, two dots and a long bar

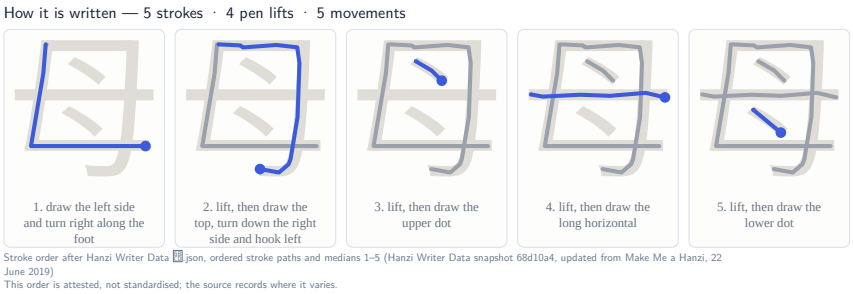
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *fùmǔ* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  父 女

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *fù*, *nǚ*

Script — a frame, two dots and a long bar



How 母 is written, stroke by stroke

母

The frame, two strokes. One that runs down the left side and turns right along the bottom. Then one that runs along the top, turns down the right side and hooks to the left at the foot.

A dot inside the top half.

A long bar right across the middle, wider than the frame on both sides.

A dot inside the bottom half.

2 + 1 + 1 + 1 = five.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 母, all five, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 母 have? (**Five.**) How many dots? (**Two, one above the long bar and one below.**) Which stroke is widest? (**The long bar across the middle.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 母, pinned stroke paths and medians.

509.4 母女 (mǔnǚ) — mother and daughter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to run the household, then the Mandarin for one's mother and father.

You'll want to know: 母女

母女 — *mǔnǚ* — "mother and daughter".

> **母女两个人都喜欢去舞会** *mǔnǚ liǎng ge rén dōu xǐhuan qù wǔhuì* — Mother and daughter both love going to dances.

Two third tones meet in this word: mǔ is said with a rising tone before nǚ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

母女 (*mǔnǚ*) is built from **母** 'a mother' and **女** 'a daughter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *muwX* and *nrjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǔnǚ*
- *Say it: mǔnǚ*, once more
- *Say it: mǔnǚ liǎng ge rén dōu xǐhuan qù wǔhuì* — Mother and daughter both love going to dances.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to run the household, then the Mandarin for one's mother and father, then say *mǔnǚ* again

Before you move on

What does **母女** mean? ("Mother and daughter".) Say it once more.

509.5 母语 (mǔyǔ) — mother tongue

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's mother and father, then the Mandarin for a mother and daughter.

You'll want to know: 母语

母语 — *mǔyǔ* — "mother tongue".

> *wǒ de mǔyǔ shì Yīngyǔ* — My mother tongue is English.

Two third tones meet in this word: mǔ is said with a rising tone before yǔ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

母语 (*mǔyǔ*) is built from **母** 'a mother' and **语** 'speech', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *muwX* and *ngjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǔyǔ*
- *Say it: mǔyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ de mǔyǔ shì Yīngyǔ* — My mother tongue is English.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's mother and father, then the Mandarin for a mother and daughter, then say *mǔyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does **母语** mean? ("Mother tongue".) Say it once more.

509.6 后妈 (hòumā) — stepmother

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a mother and daughter, then the Mandarin for one's mother tongue.

You'll want to know: 后妈

后妈 — *hòumā* — "stepmother".

> *tā xiǎoshíhou gēn hòumā zhù le wǔ nián* — As a child he lived with his stepmother for five years.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

后妈 (*hòumā*) is built from 后 'after' and 妈 'mum', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *huwX* and *muX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'after' and the second 'a mother'. It belongs to everyday speech.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hòumā*
- *Say it: hòumā*, once more
- *Say it: tā xiǎoshíhou gēn hòumā zhù le wǔ nián* — As a child he lived with his stepmother for five years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a mother and daughter, then the Mandarin for one's mother tongue, then say *hòumā* again

Before you move on

What does 后妈 mean? ("Stepmother".) Say it once more.

Chapter 510

Grandparents

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my grandma on my mother's side, grandsons and granddaughters, doting and soothing a child.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 510: I can talk about my grandma on my mother's side, grandsons and granddaughters, doting and soothing a child.*

510.1 wàipó — grandma on the mother's side

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's mother tongue, then the Mandarin for a stepmother.

You'll want to know: wàipó

wàipó — "grandma on the mother's side".

> *wǒ zài wàipó jiā zhù le yí ge yuè* — I stayed at my grandma's for a month.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wàipó is built from 外 'outside' and *pó* 'an old woman', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngwajH* and *ba* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a name for an old mother'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wàipó*
- *Say it: wàipó*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zài wàipó jiā zhù le yí ge yuè* — I stayed at my grandma's for a month.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's mother tongue, then the Mandarin for a stepmother, then say *wàipó* again

Before you move on

What does wàipó mean? ("Grandma on the mother's side".) Say it once more.

510.2 sūnzi — grandson

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a stepmother, then the Mandarin for grandma on the mother's side.

You'll want to know: sūnzi

sūnzi — "grandson".

yéye zuì xǐhuan tā de sūnzi — Grandpa loves his grandson most of all.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sūnzi is built from *sūn* 'a grandchild' and 子 'a son', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *swon* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, 'the son of a son'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūnzi*
- *Say it: sūnzi*, once more
- *Say it: yéye zuì xǐhuan tā de sūnzi* — Grandpa loves his grandson most of all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a stepmother, then the Mandarin for grandma on the mother's side, then say *sūnzi* again

Before you move on

What does sūnzi mean? ("Grandson".) Say it once more.

510.3 sūnnǚ — granddaughter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for grandma on the mother's side, then the Mandarin for a grandson.

You'll want to know: sūnnǚ

sūnnǚ — "granddaughter".

nǎinai měi tiān sòng sūnnǚ qù shàngxué — Grandma takes her granddaughter to school every day.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

sūnnǚ is built from *sūn* 'a grandchild' and 女 'a daughter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *swon* and *nrjoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūnnǚ*
- *Say it: sūnnǚ*, once more
- *Say it: nǎinai měi tiān sòng sūnnǚ qù shàngxué* — Grandma takes her granddaughter to school every day.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for grandma on the mother's side, then the Mandarin for a grandson, then say *sūnnǚ* again

Before you move on

What does sūnnǚ mean? ("Granddaughter".) Say it once more.

510.4 疼爱 (téng'ài) — to dote on

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a grandson, then the Mandarin for a granddaughter.

You'll want to know: 疼爱

疼爱 — *téng'ài* — "to dote on".

wàipó hěn téng'ài wǒ — Grandma really dotes on me.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

疼爱 (*téng'ài*) is built from 疼 'to ache' and *ài* 'to love', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *downg* and *'ojH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'pain' and the second 'to pity'; the sense 'to love dearly' is not given for the first there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: téng'ài*
- *Say it: téng'ài*, once more
- *Say it: wàipó hěn téng'ài wǒ* — Grandma really dotes on me.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a grandson, then the Mandarin for a granddaughter, then say *téng'ài* again

Before you move on

What does 疼爱 mean? ("To dote on".) Say it once more.

510.5 hǒng — to soothe a child; to coax

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a granddaughter, then the Mandarin for to dote on.

You'll want to know: hǒng

hǒng — "to soothe a child; to coax".

wàipó zuì huì hǒng háizi — Grandma is the best at soothing children.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hǒng is written with a character the Guangyun lists only as Middle Chinese *huwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'the sound of singing', which would regularly give hòng. The sense 'to soothe a child' is not given there and the third tone does not fit, so how the word came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hǒng*
- *Say it: hǒng*, once more
- *Say it: wàipó zuì huì hǒng háizi* — Grandma is the best at soothing children.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a granddaughter, then the Mandarin for to dote on, then say *hǒng* again

Before you move on

What does hǒng mean? ("To soothe a child; to coax".) Say it once more.

Chapter 511

Close Family

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my nearest and dearest, my father and mother, children by birth and doing things myself.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 511: I can talk about my nearest and dearest, my father and mother, children by birth and doing things myself.*

511.1 亲人 (qīnrén) — one's close family; one's nearest and dearest

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to dote on, then the Mandarin for to soothe a child.

You'll want to know: 亲人

亲人 — *qīnrén* — "one's close family; one's nearest and dearest".

> 在国外的时候我最想我的亲人 *zài guówài de shíhou wǒ zuì xiǎng wǒ de qīnrén* — When I was abroad, I missed my family most of all.

The new character, in pieces: 亲 — nine strokes in two pieces: on top the top of 意 *yì*, five strokes; under it four strokes, a bar, a vertical that hooks at the foot, a stroke falling left and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

亲人 (*qīnrén*) is built from 亲 'close' and 人 'a person', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshin* and *nyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to love' and 'near'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīnrén*
- *Say it: qīnrén*, once more
- *Say it: zài guówài de shíhou wǒ zuì xiǎng wǒ de qīnrén* — When I was abroad, I missed my family most of all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to dote on, then the Mandarin for to soothe a child, then say *qīnrén* again

Before you move on

What does 亲人 mean? ("One's close family; one's nearest and dearest".) Say it once more.

511.2 亲 — the top of yì, then four strokes

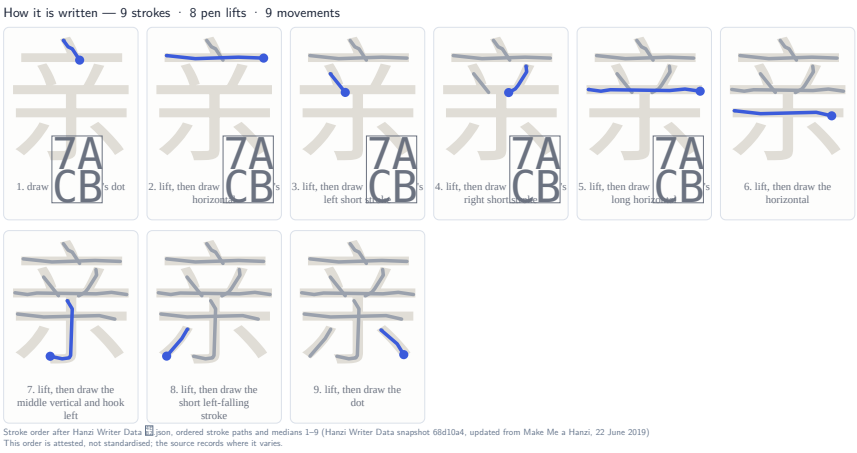
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *qīnrén* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

意 人

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yì*, *rén*

Script — the top of yì, then four strokes



How 亲 *is written, stroke by stroke*

亲

Two pieces, top before bottom.

The top, five strokes, as on top of 意: a dot, a bar, a dot on the left and a short stroke falling to the left on the right, then a long bar.

The bottom, four strokes: a bar, a vertical down the middle that hooks to the left at the foot, a short stroke falling to the left, and a dot falling to the right.

5 + 4 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 亲, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 亲 have? (**Two**.) Which character you know has the same top? (意.) How does the middle vertical end? (**With a hook to the left**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 亲, pinned stroke paths and medians.

511.3 父亲 (fùqīn) — father (the formal word)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to soothe a child, then the Mandarin for one's nearest and dearest.

You'll want to know: 父亲

父亲 — *fùqīn* — "father (the formal word)".

我父亲在大学教了三十年汉语 *wǒ fùqīn zài dàxué jiāo le sānshí nián Hànyǔ* — My father taught Chinese at a university for thirty years.

Many speakers make the second syllable light: fùqin.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

父亲 (*fùqīn*) is built from 父 'a father' and 亲 'close', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjuX* and *tshin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fùqīn*
- *Say it: fùqīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ fùqīn zài dàxué jiāo le sānshí nián Hànyǔ* — My father taught Chinese at a university for thirty years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to soothe a child, then the Mandarin for one's nearest and dearest, then say *fùqīn* again

Before you move on

What does 父亲 mean? ("Father (the formal word)".) Say it once more.

511.4 母亲 (mǔqīn) — mother (the formal word)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's nearest and dearest, then the Mandarin for father (the formal word).

You'll want to know: 母亲

母亲 — *mǔqīn* — "mother (the formal word)".

我母亲比我父亲大两岁 *wǒ mǔqīn bǐ wǒ fùqīn dà liǎng suì* — My mother is two years older than my father.

Many speakers make the second syllable light: mǔqin.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

母亲 (*mǔqīn*) is built from 母 'a mother' and 亲 'close', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *muwX* and *tshin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǔqīn*
- *Say it: mǔqīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ mǔqīn bǐ wǒ fùqīn dà liǎng suì* — My mother is two years older than my father.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's nearest and dearest, then the Mandarin for father (the formal word), then say *mǔqīn* again

Before you move on

What does 母亲 mean? ("Mother (the formal word)".) Say it once more.

511.5 亲生 (qīnshēng) — one's own (by birth)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for father (the formal word), then the Mandarin for mother (the formal word).

You'll want to know: 亲生

亲生 — *qīnshēng* — "one's own (by birth)".

tāmen bú shì qīnshēng xiōngdì — They aren't brothers by birth.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

亲生 (*qīnshēng*) is built from 亲 'close' and 生 'to be born', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshin* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to grow'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīnshēng*
- *Say it: qīnshēng*, once more
- *Say it: tāmen bú shì qīnshēng xiōngdì* — They aren't brothers by birth.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for father (the formal word), then the Mandarin for mother (the formal word), then say *qīnshēng* again

Before you move on

What does 亲生 mean? ("One's own (by birth)".) Say it once more.

511.6 亲自 (qīnzì) — personally (doing it oneself)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for mother (the formal word), then the Mandarin for one's own (by birth).

You'll want to know: 亲自

亲自 — *qīnzì* — "personally (doing it oneself)".

> 妈妈亲自来学校看我 *māma qīnzì lái xuéxiào kàn wǒ* — Mum came to school to see me herself.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

亲自 (*qīnzì*) is built from 亲 'close' and 自 'self', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshin* and *dzijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'from'; the sense 'self' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīnzì*
- *Say it: qīnzì*, once more
- *Say it: māma qīnzì lái xuéxiào kàn wǒ* — Mum came to school to see me herself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for mother (the formal word), then the Mandarin for one's own (by birth), then say *qīnzì* again

Before you move on

What does 亲自 mean? ("Personally (doing it oneself)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 512

Dreams

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about my ambition in life, chasing a dream, making something of myself, fame and top schools.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 512: I can talk about my ambition in life, chasing a dream, making something of myself, fame and top schools.*

512.1 zhìxiàng — ambition in life; the goal one sets oneself

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's own (by birth), then the Mandarin for personally (doing it oneself).

You'll want to know: zhìxiàng

zhìxiàng — "ambition in life; the goal one sets oneself".

> *wǒ zuì dà de zhìxiàng shì dāng yīshēng* — My greatest ambition is to be a doctor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhìxiàng is built from *zhì* 'a longing' and *xiàng* 'to face', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyiH* and *xjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription), which glosses the first 'what the mind longs for' and the second 'to face'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhìxiàng*
- *Say it: zhìxiàng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì dà de zhìxiàng shì dāng yīshēng* — My greatest ambition is to be a doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's own (by birth), then the Mandarin for personally (doing it oneself), then say *zhìxiàng* again

Before you move on

What does zhìxiàng mean? ("Ambition in life; the goal one sets oneself".) Say it once more.

512.2 zhuīqiú — to pursue (a goal); to chase a dream

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for personally (doing it oneself), then the Mandarin for one's ambition in life.

You'll want to know: zhuīqiú

zhuīqiú — "to pursue (a goal); to chase a dream".

wǒ xiǎng zhuīqiú zìjǐ de mèngxiǎng — I want to follow my own dream.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhuīqiú is built from *zhuī* 'to chase' and *qiú* 'to seek', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trwij* and *gjuw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to chase' and the second 'to search for'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuīqiú*
- *Say it: zhuīqiú*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng zhuīqiú zìjǐ de mèngxiǎng* — I want to follow my own dream.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for personally (doing it oneself), then the Mandarin for one's ambition in life, then say *zhuīqiú* again

Before you move on

What does zhuīqiú mean? ("To pursue (a goal); to chase a dream".) Say it once more.

512.3 成才 (chéngcái) — to make something of oneself

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for one's ambition in life, then the Mandarin for to pursue (a goal).

You'll want to know: 成才

成才 — *chéngcái* — "to make something of oneself".

tā cóngxiǎo nǔlì xuéxí hòulái chéngcái le — He studied hard from childhood and later made something of himself.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成才 (*chéngcái*) is built from 成 'to become' and 才 'talent', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *dzoj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to complete' and the second 'ability' and 'a gift for letters'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngcái*
- *Say it: chéngcái*, once more
- *Say it: tā cóngxiǎo nǔlì xuéxí hòulái chéngcái le* — He studied hard from childhood and later made something of himself.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for one's ambition in life, then the Mandarin for to pursue (a goal), then say *chéngcái* again

Before you move on

What does 成才 mean? ("To make something of oneself".) Say it once more.

512.4 成名 (chéngmíng) — to become famous

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to pursue (a goal), then the Mandarin for to make something of oneself.

You'll want to know: 成名

成名 — *chéngmíng* — "to become famous".

成名以后他感觉很不开心 *chéngmíng yǐhòu tā gǎnjué hěn bù kāixīn* — After he became famous, he felt very unhappy.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成名 (*chéngmíng*) is built from 成 'to complete' and 名 'a name', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *mjieng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a name' and 'a title'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngmíng*
- *Say it: chéngmíng*, once more
- *Say it: chéngmíng yǐhòu tā gǎnjué hěn bù kāixīn* — After he became famous, he felt very unhappy.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to pursue (a goal), then the Mandarin for to make something of oneself, then say *chéngmíng* again

Before you move on

What does 成名 mean? ("To become famous".) Say it once more.

512.5 名校 (míngxiào) — top school; famous university

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make something of oneself, then the Mandarin for to become famous.

You'll want to know: 名校

名校 — *míngxiào* — "top school; famous university".

我想考上名校 *wǒ xiǎng kǎoshàng míngxiào* — I want to get into a top school.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

名校 (*míngxiào*) is built from 名 'a name' and 校 'a school', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjieng* and *haewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the title of an officer; the sense 'a school' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: míngxiào*
- *Say it: míngxiào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng kǎoshàng míngxiào* — I want to get into a top school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make something of oneself, then the Mandarin for to become famous, then say *míngxiào* again

Before you move on

What does 名校 mean? ("Top school; famous university".) Say it once more.

Chapter 513

Ambitions

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about starting a business, reaching a goal, striving for it and doing it with my own hands.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 513: I can talk about starting a business, reaching a goal, striving for it and doing it with my own hands.*

513.1 chuàngyè — to start a business; to found an enterprise

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to become famous, then the Mandarin for a top school.

You'll want to know: chuàngyè

chuàngyè — "to start a business; to found an enterprise".

> *dàxué bìyè yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng zìjǐ chuàngyè* — After university I want to start my own business.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuàngyè is built from *chuàng* 'to found' and 业 'an undertaking', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsrhjangH* and *ngjaep* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription). The dictionary gives the first as another spelling of a word it glosses, after an older dictionary, 'to found a craft and begin an undertaking'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuàngyè*
- *Say it: chuàngyè*, once more
- *Say it: dàxué bìyè yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng zìjǐ chuàngyè* — After university I want to start my own business.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to become famous, then the Mandarin for a top school, then say *chuàngyè* again

Before you move on

What does chuàngyè mean? ("To start a business; to found an enterprise".) Say it once more.

513.2 dádào — to attain (a goal); to reach a level

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a top school, then the Mandarin for to start a business.

You'll want to know: dádào

dádào — "to attain (a goal); to reach a level".

tā xué le sān nián dádào le zìjǐ de mùbiāo — He studied for three years and reached his goal.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dádào is built from *dá* 'to get through' and 到 'to arrive', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dat* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to reach through' and the second 'to arrive'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dádào*
- *Say it: dádào*, once more
- *Say it: tā xué le sān nián dádào le zìjǐ de mùbiāo* — He studied for three years and reached his goal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a top school, then the Mandarin for to start a business, then say *dádào* again

Before you move on

What does dádào mean? ("To attain (a goal); to reach a level".) Say it once more.

513.3 zhēngqǔ — to strive for; to fight for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to start a business, then the Mandarin for to attain (a goal).

You'll want to know: zhēngqǔ

zhēngqǔ — "to strive for; to fight for".

wǒ yào zhēngqǔ kǎoshàng míngxiào — I'm going to do my best to get into a top school.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhēngqǔ is built from *zhēng* 'to contend' and 取 'to take', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsreang* and *tshjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to compete' and the second 'to receive'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhēngqǔ*
- *Say it: zhēngqǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ yào zhēngqǔ kǎoshàng míngxiào* — I'm going to do my best to get into a top school.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to start a business, then the Mandarin for to attain (a goal), then say *zhēngqǔ* again

Before you move on

What does zhēngqǔ mean? ("To strive for; to fight for".) Say it once more.

513.4 fèndòu — to struggle (towards a goal)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to attain (a goal), then the Mandarin for to strive for.

You'll want to know: fèndòu

fèndòu — "to struggle (towards a goal)".

tā fèndòu le shí nián cái chénggōng — He struggled for ten years before he succeeded.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

fèndòu is built from *fèn* 'to spread the wings' and *dòu* 'to fight', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjunH* and *tuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a bird spreading its feathers and the second, after an older dictionary, as two men facing each other with weapons.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fèndòu*
- *Say it: fèndòu*, once more
- *Say it: tā fèndòu le shí nián cái chénggōng* — He struggled for ten years before he succeeded.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to attain (a goal), then the Mandarin for to strive for, then say *fèndòu* again

Before you move on

What does fèndòu mean? ("To struggle (towards a goal)".) Say it once more.

513.5 亲手 (qīnshǒu) — with one's own hands

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to strive for, then the Mandarin for to struggle (towards a goal).

You'll want to know: 亲手

亲手 — *qīnshǒu* — "with one's own hands".

我想亲手开一家饭店 *wǒ xiǎng qīnshǒu kāi yì jiā fàndiàn* — I want to open a restaurant with my own hands.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

亲手 (*qīnshǒu*) is built from 亲 'close' and 手 'a hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshin* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīnshǒu*
- *Say it: qīnshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiǎng qīnshǒu kāi yì jiā fàndiàn* — I want to open a restaurant with my own hands.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to strive for, then the Mandarin for to struggle (towards a goal), then say *qīnshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does 亲手 mean? ("With one's own hands".) Say it once more.

513.6 Looking back: from Parents to Ambitions

Say the Mandarin for to run the household and one's mother and father.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to run the household, one's mother and father, a mother and daughter, one's mother tongue, a stepmother
- *Say it:* grandma on the mother's side, a grandson, a granddaughter, to dote on, to soothe a child
- *Say it:* one's nearest and dearest, father (the formal word), mother (the formal word), one's own (by birth), personally (doing it oneself)

- *Say it:* one's ambition in life, to pursue (a goal), to make something of oneself, to become famous, a top school
- *Say it:* to start a business, to attain (a goal), to strive for, to struggle (towards a goal), with one's own hands
- *Read it:* 母 亲 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To run the household? (当家, *dāngjiā.*) One's mother and father? (父母, *fùmǔ.*) A mother and daughter? (母女, *mǔnǚ.*) One's mother tongue? (母语, *mǔyǔ.*) A stepmother? (后妈, *hòumā.*) Grandma on the mother's side? (*wàipó.*) A grandson? (*sūnzi.*) A granddaughter? (*sūnnǚ.*) To dote on? (疼爱, *téng'ài.*) To soothe a child? (*hǒng.*) One's nearest and dearest? (亲人, *qīnrén.*) Father (the formal word)? (父亲, *fùqīn.*) Mother (the formal word)? (母亲, *mǔqīn.*) One's own (by birth)? (亲生, *qīnshēng.*) Personally (doing it oneself)? (亲自, *qīnzì.*) One's ambition in life? (*zhìxiàng.*) To pursue (a goal)? (*zhuīqiú.*) To make something of oneself? (成才, *chéngcái.*) To become famous? (成名, *chéngmíng.*) A top school? (名校, *míngxiào.*) To start a business? (*chuàngyè.*) To attain (a goal)? (*dádào.*) To strive for? (*zhēngqǔ.*) To struggle (towards a goal)? (*fèndòu.*) With one's own hands? (亲手, *qīnshǒu.*)

513.7 Ambitions — once more

Say the Mandarin for to start a business and to attain (a goal).

Your turn

- *Say it:* to start a business, to attain (a goal), to strive for, to struggle (towards a goal), with one's own hands

Before you move on

To start a business? (*chuàngyè.*) To attain (a goal)? (*dádào.*) To strive for? (*zhēngqǔ.*) To struggle (towards a goal)? (*fèndòu.*) With one's own hands? (亲手, *qīnshǒu.*)

Chapter 514

When the Weather Turns

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about wind and storms, getting caught in the rain, things that freeze and snow that melts.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 514: I can talk about wind and storms, getting caught in the rain, things that freeze and snow that melts.*

514.1 shǎndiàn — lightning

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to struggle, then the Mandarin for with one's own hands.

You'll want to know: shǎndiàn

shǎndiàn — "lightning".

> *wǒ zuì pà dǎléi hé shǎndiàn* — Thunder and lightning are what I'm most afraid of.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shǎndiàn is built from *shǎn* and *diàn* 'lightning', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syemX* and *denH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the look of something coming out of a door, and explains the second as the flash when yin

and yang clash; the sense 'to flash' is not given for the first.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǎndiàn*
- *Say it: shǎndiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì pà dǎléi hé shǎndiàn* — Thunder and lightning are what I'm most afraid of.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to struggle, then the Mandarin for with one's own hands, then say *shǎndiàn* again

Before you move on

What does shǎndiàn mean? ("Lightning".) Say it once more.

514.2 línyǔ — to get caught in the rain

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for with one's own hands, then the Mandarin for a flash of lightning.

You'll want to know: línyǔ

línyǔ — "to get caught in the rain".

zuótiān línyǔ yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn lěng — After I got caught in the rain yesterday, I felt cold.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

línyǔ is built from *lín* 'to pour on' and 雨 'rain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lim* and *hjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as pouring water over something: to be poured on by the rain.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: línyǔ*
- *Say it: línyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: zuótiān línyǔ yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn lěng* — After I got caught in the rain yesterday, I felt cold.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for with one's own hands, then the Mandarin for a flash of lightning, then say *línyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does línyǔ mean? ("To get caught in the rain".) Say it once more.

514.3 léiyǔ — thunderstorm

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a flash of lightning, then the Mandarin for to get caught in the rain.

You'll want to know: léiyǔ

léiyǔ — "thunderstorm".

wàipó shuō jīntiān wǎnshang yǒu léiyǔ — Grandma says there'll be a thunderstorm tonight.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

léiyǔ is built from *léi* 'thunder' and 雨 'rain', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lwoj* and *hjuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the first, after an older book, as yin and yang striking each other.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: léiyǔ*
- *Say it: léiyǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wàipó shuō jīntiān wǎnshang yǒu léiyǔ* — Grandma says there'll be a thunderstorm tonight.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a flash of lightning, then the Mandarin for to get caught in the rain, then say *léiyǔ* again

Before you move on

What does léiyǔ mean? ("Thunderstorm".) Say it once more.

514.4 dòngjiāng — to be frozen stiff

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get caught in the rain, then the Mandarin for a thunderstorm.

You'll want to know: dòngjiāng

dòngjiāng — "to be frozen stiff".

wǒ děng le yí ge xiǎoshí shǒu dōu dòngjiāng le — I waited an hour, and my hands were frozen stiff.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dòngjiāng is built from *dòng* 'to freeze' and *jiāng* 'stiff', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tuwngH* and *kjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'ice, freezing' and the second as falling over flat.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dòngjiāng*
- *Say it: dòngjiāng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ děng le yí ge xiǎoshí shǒu dōu dòngjiāng le* — I waited an hour, and my hands were frozen stiff.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get caught in the rain, then the Mandarin for a thunderstorm, then say *dòngjiāng* again

Before you move on

What does dòngjiāng mean? ("To be frozen stiff".) Say it once more.

514.5 rónghuà — to melt; to thaw

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a thunderstorm, then the Mandarin for to be frozen stiff.

You'll want to know: rónghuà

rónghuà — "to melt; to thaw".

tiānqì nuǎnhuo le xuěrén dōu rónghuà le — It turned warm, and the snowmen all melted.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rónghuà is built from *róng* and *huà* 'to change', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yuwng* and *xwaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'harmonious' and 'bright' and, after an older book, as steam rising from a cooking pot; the second it glosses 'to change, to transform'. How the pair came to mean melting is usually explained as warmth changing a thing, but it

is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: rónghuà*
- *Say it: rónghuà*, once more
- *Say it: tiānqì nuǎnhuo le xuěrén dōu rónghuà le* — It turned warm, and the snowmen all melted.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a thunderstorm, then the Mandarin for to be frozen stiff, then say *rónghuà* again

Before you move on

What does rónghuà mean? ("To melt; to thaw".) Say it once more.

Chapter 515

Four Seasons

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the four seasons, the rainy season, bitter cold, getting away from the heat and the harvest.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 515: I can talk about the four seasons, the rainy season, bitter cold, getting away from the heat and the harvest.*

515.1 hánlěng — bitterly cold (of a climate)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be frozen stiff, then the Mandarin for to melt.

You'll want to know: hánlěng

hánlěng — "bitterly cold (of a climate)".

> *zhèr de dōngtiān bǐ Běijīng hánlěng* — Winters here are colder than in Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

hánlěng is built from *hán* and 冷 'cold', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *han* and *lengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'cold, as against heat'; it lists the second three times, *leng*, *laengX* and *lengX*, the last two glossed 'cold'. Two

words for cold, put together, make it bitter.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: hánlěng*
- *Say it: hánlěng*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de dōngtiān bǐ Běijīng hánlěng* — Winters here are colder than in Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be frozen stiff, then the Mandarin for to melt, then say *hánlěng* again

Before you move on

What does hánlěng mean? ("Bitterly cold (of a climate)".) Say it once more.

515.2 四季 (sìjì) — the four seasons

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to melt, then the Mandarin for bitterly cold.

You'll want to know: 四季

四季 — *sìjì* — "the four seasons".

这儿四季都有花 *zhèr sìjì dōu yǒu huā* — There are flowers here all year round.

The new character, in pieces: 季 — eight strokes in two pieces: on top the grain piece, five strokes, as on the left of 秋, but spread wide; and 子 at the foot, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

四季 (*sìjì*) is built from 四 'four' and 季, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sijH* and *kjwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second as the youngest of brothers and 'young'; how it came to mean a season, as in 季节, is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: sìjì*
- *Say it: sìjì*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr sìjì dōu yǒu huā* — There are flowers here all year round.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to melt, then the Mandarin for bitterly cold, then say *sìjì* again

Before you move on

What does 四季 mean? ("The four seasons".) Say it once more.

515.3 季 — the grain piece, then 子 under it

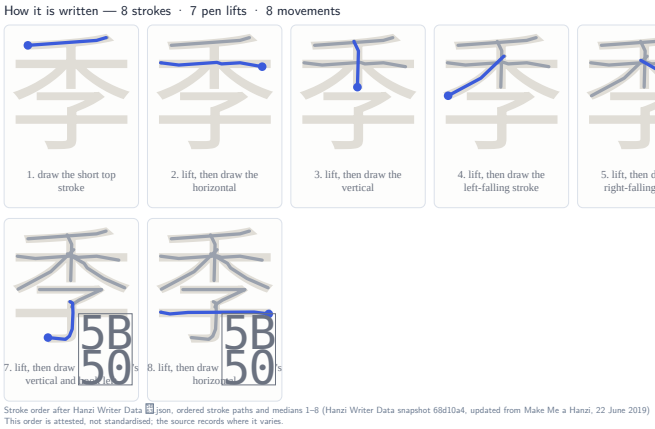
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *sìjì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  秋 子

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *qiū*, *zǐ*

Script — the grain piece, then 子 under it



How 季 is written, stroke by stroke

季

Two pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, the grain piece, five strokes, as on the left of 秋, but spread out wide: a short stroke falling to the left at the top, a bar, a short vertical down through the bar, a stroke falling to the left from the crossing, then a long stroke falling to the right.

The bottom piece, 子, three strokes, as you wrote it: a bar that turns down to the left, a vertical that curves down and hooks to the left, then a long bar across.

5 + 3 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 季, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 季 have? (**Two: the grain piece on top and 子 at the foot.**) How many strokes? (**Eight: five and three.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 季, pinned stroke paths and medians.

515.4 雨季 (yǔjì) — rainy season

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bitterly cold, then the Mandarin for the four seasons.

You'll want to know: 雨季

雨季 — *yǔjì* — "rainy season".

我最不喜欢雨季 *wǒ zuì bù xǐhuan yǔjì* — I like the rainy season least of all.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

雨季 (*yǔjì*) is built from 雨 'rain' and 季 'a season', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuX* and *kjwijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the second as the youngest of brothers, so its sense 'season' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǔjì*
- *Say it: yǔjì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì bù xǐhuan yǔjì* — I like the rainy season least of all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bitterly cold, then the Mandarin for the four seasons, then say *yǔjì* again

Before you move on

What does 雨季 mean? ("Rainy season".) Say it once more.

515.5 bìshǔ — to escape the summer heat

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the four seasons, then the Mandarin for the rainy season.

You'll want to know: bìshǔ

bìshǔ — "to escape the summer heat".

> *xiàtiān wǒ hé fùmǔ qù shān lǐ bìshǔ* — In summer I go up into the hills with my parents to get away from the heat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bìshǔ is built from *bì* 'to avoid' and *shǔ* 'heat', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *bjieH* and *syoX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to turn away from' and the second 'heat'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bìshǔ*
- *Say it: bìshǔ*, once more
- *Say it: xiàtiān wǒ hé fùmǔ qù shān lǐ bìshǔ* — In summer I go up into the hills with my parents to get away from the heat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the four seasons, then the Mandarin for the rainy season, then say *bìshǔ* again

Before you move on

What does bìshǔ mean? ("To escape the summer heat".) Say it once more.

515.6 shōuhuò — to bring in the harvest; to reap

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the rainy season, then the Mandarin for to escape the summer heat.

You'll want to know: shōuhuò

shōuhuò — "to bring in the harvest; to reap".

> *qiūtiān shì shōuhuò de jìjié* — Autumn is the season for bringing in the harvest.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shōuhuò is built from *shōu* 'to gather in' and *huò* 'to reap', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syuw* and *hwak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to collect' and the second, written with the grain piece, 'to cut down the crop'. The falling tone of huò is not the regular outcome of *hwak*, which would give huó.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shōuhuò*
- *Say it: shōuhuò*, once more
- *Say it: qiūtiān shì shōuhuò de jìjié* — Autumn is the season for bringing in the harvest.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the rainy season, then the Mandarin for to escape the summer heat, then say *shōuhuò* again

Before you move on

What does shōuhuò mean? ("To bring in the harvest; to reap".) Say it once more.

Chapter 516

Trees and Leaves

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about trees, fruit trees, woods, fallen leaves and fruit that is not ripe yet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 516: I can talk about trees, fruit trees, woods, fallen leaves and fruit that is not ripe yet.*

516.1 luòyè — fallen leaves

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to escape the summer heat, then the Mandarin for to bring in the harvest.

You'll want to know: luòyè

luòyè — "fallen leaves".

> *qiūtiān gōngyuán lǐ dōu shì luòyè* — In autumn the park is full of fallen leaves.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

luòyè is built from *luò* 'to fall' and *yè* 'a leaf', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *lak* and *yep* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary says the first is the word for what trees do when their leaves come down, and glosses the second 'branches and leaves'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: luòyè*
- *Say it: luòyè*, once more
- *Say it: qiūtiān gōngyuán lǐ dōu shì luòyè* — In autumn the park is full of fallen leaves.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to escape the summer heat, then the Mandarin for to bring in the harvest, then say *luòyè* again

Before you move on

What does luòyè mean? ("Fallen leaves".) Say it once more.

516.2 树 (shù) — tree

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to bring in the harvest, then the Mandarin for fallen leaves.

You'll want to know: 树

树 — *shù* — "tree".

秋天的树最好看 *qiūtiān de shù zuì hǎokàn* — Trees look their best in autumn.

The new character, in pieces: 树 — nine strokes in three pieces: on the left the tree piece, four strokes, as in 机; in the middle 又, two strokes, the second shrunk to a short stroke; and on the right a bar, a vertical that hooks to the left, and a dot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

树 (*shù*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *dzyuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed as the general name for trees and 'to set up'; the dictionary also lists *dzyuX*, glossed 'to prop up'. The falling

tone of shù comes from *dzyuH*.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shù*
- *Say it: shù*, once more
- *Say it: qiūtiān de shù zuì hǎokàn* — Trees look their best in autumn.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to bring in the harvest, then the Mandarin for fallen leaves, then say *shù* again

Before you move on

What does 树 mean? ("Tree".) Say it once more.

516.3 树 — the tree piece, 又, and three strokes on the right

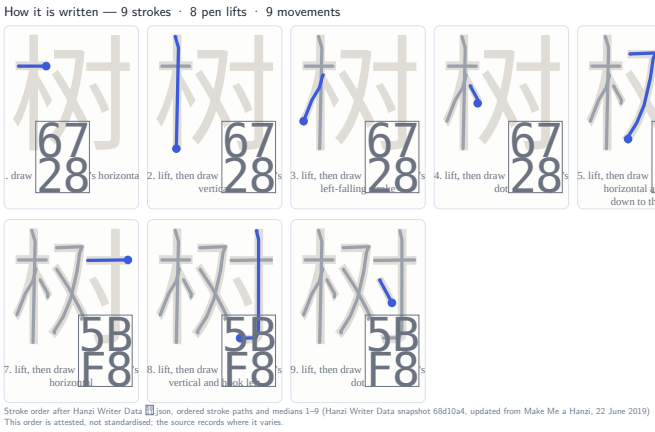
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *shù* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  机 又

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *jī*, *yòu*

Script — the tree piece, 又, and three strokes on the right



How 树 is written, stroke by stroke

树

Three pieces, left to right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the tree piece, four strokes, narrow, as in 机: a short bar, a vertical down through it, a stroke falling to the left from the crossing, then a short dot to the right.

The middle piece, 又, two strokes: a short bar that turns into a stroke falling to the left, then a short stroke falling to the right across it.

The right piece, three strokes: a bar, a long vertical down the right side that hooks to the left at the foot, then a dot on the left of the vertical.

4 + 2 + 3 = nine.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 树, all nine, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 树 have? (**Three: the tree piece, 又 and a right piece.**) What is the last stroke? (**A dot beside the**

hooked vertical.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 树, pinned stroke paths and medians.

516.4 果树 (guǒshù) — fruit tree

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fallen leaves, then the Mandarin for a tree.

You'll want to know: 果树

果树 — *guǒshù* — "fruit tree".

我外公家有一些果树 *wǒ wàigōng jiā yǒu yìxiē guǒshù* — There are some fruit trees at my grandad's.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

果树 (*guǒshù*) is built from 果 'fruit' and 树 'a tree', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kwaX* and *dzyuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'bold' and 'firm', and also 'the fruit of a tree'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: guǒshù*
- *Say it: guǒshù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ wàigōng jiā yǒu yìxiē guǒshù* — There are some fruit trees at my grandad's.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fallen leaves, then the Mandarin for a tree, then say *guǒshù* again

Before you move on

What does 果树 mean? ("Fruit tree".) Say it once more.

516.5 shùlín — woods; a grove

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a tree, then the Mandarin for a fruit tree.

You'll want to know: shùlín

shùlín — "woods; a grove".

wǒ hé sūnnǚ zài shùlín lǐ zǒu le liǎng ge xiǎoshí — My granddaughter and I walked in the woods for two hours.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shùlín is built from 树 'a tree' and *lín* 'a wood', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyuH* and *lim* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says, after an older dictionary, that land out in the open is called *lim*, and after another, that flat land with stands of trees is.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shùlín*
- *Say it: shùlín*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hé sūnnǚ zài shùlín lǐ zǒu le liǎng ge xiǎoshí* — My granddaughter and I walked in the woods for two hours.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a tree, then the Mandarin for a fruit tree, then say *shùlín* again

Before you move on

What does shùlín mean? ("Woods; a grove".) Say it once more.

516.6 chéngshú — to ripen; to be ripe

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a fruit tree, then the Mandarin for the woods.

You'll want to know: chéngshú

chéngshú — "to ripen; to be ripe".

> *zhèxiē píngguǒ hái méiyǒu chéngshú* — These apples aren't ripe yet.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngshú is built from 成 'to complete' and *shú*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *dzyuwk* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'finished' and the second with the first: done, as fruit is done when it is ripe.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngshú*
- *Say it: chéngshú*, once more
- *Say it: zhèxiē píngguǒ hái méiyǒu chéngshú* — These apples aren't ripe yet.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a fruit tree, then the Mandarin for the woods, then say *chéngshú* again

Before you move on

What does chéngshú mean? ("To ripen; to be ripe".) Say it once more.

Chapter 517

Light in the Dark

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about light, things that shine, starlight, dusk and the time it gets light.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 517: I can talk about light, things that shine, starlight, dusk and the time it gets light.*

517.1 tiānliàng — to get light at dawn

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the woods, then the Mandarin for to ripen.

You'll want to know: tiānliàng

tiānliàng — "to get light at dawn".

> *wàipó shuō dōngtiān qī diǎn cái tiānliàng* — Grandma says it doesn't get light until seven in winter.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tiānliàng is built from 天 'the sky' and *liàng* 'bright', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *then* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'bright' and 'clear'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiānliàng*
- *Say it: tiānliàng*, once more
- *Say it: wàipó shuō dōngtiān qī diǎn cái tiānliàng* — Grandma says it doesn't get light until seven in winter.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the woods, then the Mandarin for to ripen, then say *tiānliàng* again

Before you move on

What does tiānliàng mean? ("To get light at dawn".) Say it once more.

517.2 光 (guāng) — light from the sun or a lamp

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to ripen, then the Mandarin for to get light at dawn.

You'll want to know: 光

光 — *guāng* — "light from the sun or a lamp".

停电以后房间里没有光了 *tíngdiàn yǐhòu fángjiān lǐ méiyǒu guāng le* — After the power went off, there was no light in the room.

The new character, in pieces: 光 — six strokes in three pieces: on top a short vertical with a dot on each side, three strokes; a long bar across the middle; and 儿 at the foot, two strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

光 (*guāng*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *kwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'bright'; the dictionary also lists a departing-tone reading, *kwangH*, for adding colour. The noun 'light' is not glossed there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: guāng*
- *Say it: guāng*, once more
- *Say it: tíngdiàn yǐhòu fángjiān lǐ méiyǒu guāng le* — After the power went off, there was no light in the room.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to ripen, then the Mandarin for to get light at dawn, then say *guāng* again

Before you move on

What does 光 mean? ("Light from the sun or a lamp".) Say it once more.

517.3 光 — three short strokes, a bar, then 儿

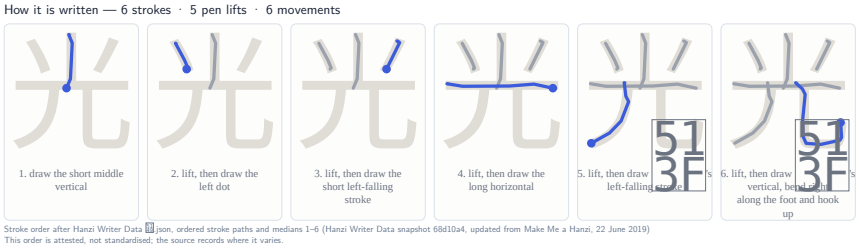
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *guāng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  儿 先

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *ér*, *xiān*

Script — three short strokes, a bar, then 儿



How 光 is written, stroke by stroke

光

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, three strokes: a short vertical down the middle, a dot on its left, then a short stroke on its right falling to the left.

One long bar across the middle, under them.

The bottom piece, 儿, two strokes, as you wrote it: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical that bends right along the foot and hooks up.

3 + 1 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 光, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 光 have? (**Six**.) What sits at its foot? (儿, **two strokes**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 光, pinned stroke paths and medians.

517.4 发光 (fāguāng) — to give off light; to shine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get light at dawn, then the Mandarin for light from the sun.

You'll want to know: 发光

发光 — *fāguāng* — "to give off light; to shine".

> 星星为什么会发光 *xīngxing wèishénme huì fāguāng* — Why do the stars shine?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

发光 (*fāguāng*) is built from 发 'to send out' and 光 'light', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjot* and *kwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to start' and 'to open out' and the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāguāng*
- *Say it: fāguāng*, once more
- *Say it: xīngxing wèishénme huì fāguāng* — Why do the stars shine?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get light at dawn, then the Mandarin for light from the sun, then say *fāguāng* again

Before you move on

What does 发光 mean? ("To give off light; to shine".) Say it once more.

517.5 星光 (xīngguāng) — starlight

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for light from the sun, then the Mandarin for to give off light.

You'll want to know: 星光

星光 — *xīngguāng* — "starlight".

> 山里的星光最好看 *shān lǐ de xīngguāng zuì hǎokàn* — The starlight is loveliest up in the hills.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

星光 (*xīngguāng*) is built from 星 'a star' and 光 'light', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *seng* and *kwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīngguāng*
- *Say it: xīngguāng*, once more
- *Say it: shān lǐ de xīngguāng zuì hǎokàn* — The starlight is loveliest up in the hills.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for light from the sun, then the Mandarin for to give off light, then say *xīngguāng* again

Before you move on

What does 星光 mean? ("Starlight".) Say it once more.

517.6 huánghūn — twilight; the fading light of evening

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give off light, then the Mandarin for starlight.

You'll want to know: huánghūn

huánghūn — "twilight; the fading light of evening".

> *wǒ zuì xǐhuan huánghūn de shíhou qù sànbù* — Twilight is my favourite time for a walk.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huánghūn is built from *huáng* 'yellow' and *hūn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwang* and *xwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the colour of the centre and, after an older dictionary, the second as the sun gone dark.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huánghūn*
- *Say it: huánghūn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuì xǐhuan huánghūn de shíhou qù sànbù* — Twilight is my favourite time for a walk.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give off light, then the Mandarin for starlight, then say *huánghūn* again

Before you move on

What does huánghūn mean? ("Twilight; the fading light of evening".) Say it once more.

Chapter 518

Sunshine

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about clear skies, sunshine, solar power, umbrellas against the sun and fog.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 518: I can talk about clear skies, sunshine, solar power, umbrellas against the sun and fog.*

518.1 qínglǎng — clear and cloudless (of the sky)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for starlight, then the Mandarin for twilight.

You'll want to know: qínglǎng

qínglǎng — "clear and cloudless (of the sky)".

> *míngtiān tiānqì qínglǎng wǒmen qù gōngyuán* — It'll be clear tomorrow, so we're going to the park.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qínglǎng is built from *qíng* and *lǎng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjeng* and *langX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as the sky clearing and the second 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qínglǎng*
- *Say it: qínglǎng*, once more
- *Say it: míngtiān tiānqì qínglǎng wǒmen qù gōngyuán* — It'll be clear tomorrow, so we're going to the park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for starlight, then the Mandarin for twilight, then say *qínglǎng* again

Before you move on

What does qínglǎng mean? ("Clear and cloudless (of the sky)".) Say it once more.

518.2 阳光 (yángguāng) — sunshine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for twilight, then the Mandarin for clear and cloudless.

You'll want to know: 阳光

阳光 — *yángguāng* — "sunshine".

这个季节的阳光最好 *zhège jìjié de yángguāng zuì hǎo* — The sunshine is at its best at this time of year.

The new character, in pieces: 阳 — six strokes in two pieces: on the left the ear piece, two strokes, as on the right of 那; on the right 日, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

阳光 (*yángguāng*) is built from 阳 and 光 'light', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *yang* and *kwang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the yang of yin and

yang and, after an older book, 'high and bright'; the light of the yang is the sun's.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yángguāng*
- *Say it: yángguāng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège jìjié de yángguāng zuì hǎo* — The sunshine is at its best at this time of year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for twilight, then the Mandarin for clear and cloudless, then say *yángguāng* again

Before you move on

What does 阳光 mean? ("Sunshine".) Say it once more.

518.3 阳 — the ear piece on the left, then 日

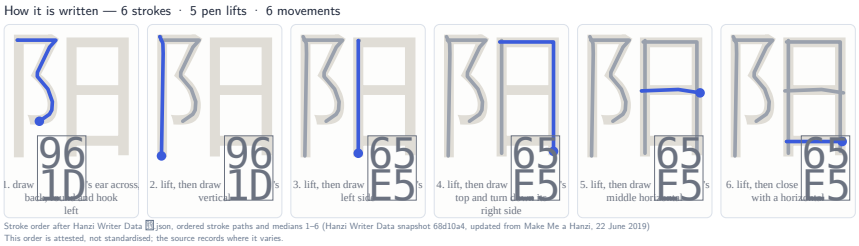
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yángguāng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  那 日

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nà*, *rì*

Script — the ear piece on the left, then 日



How 阳 is written, stroke by stroke

阳

Two pieces, left before right. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the ear, two strokes, as on the right of 那 and 都: one stroke that runs right, folds down twice like an ear and hooks, then a long vertical down its left edge.

The right piece, 日, four strokes, as you wrote it: a vertical, a bar that turns down the right side, a bar across the middle, then a bar closing the foot.

2 + 4 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 阳, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 阳 have? (**Two: the ear and 日.**) Which comes first? (**The ear, on the left.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 阳, pinned stroke paths and medians.

518.4 太阳能 (tàiyángnéng) — solar energy; solar power

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for clear and cloudless, then the Mandarin for sunshine.

You'll want to know: 太阳能

太阳能 — *tàiyángnéng* — "solar energy; solar power".

> 我们家用了五年太阳能 *wǒmen jiā yòng le wǔ nián tàiyángnéng* — We've used solar power at home for five years.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

太阳能 (*tàiyángnéng*) is built from 太阳 'the sun' and 能 'energy', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *thajH*, *yang* and *nong* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the last 'skilled' and 'able'; the sense 'energy' is modern, and is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tàiyángnéng*
- *Say it: tàiyángnéng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiā yòng le wǔ nián tàiyángnéng* — We've used solar power at home for five years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for clear and cloudless, then the Mandarin for sunshine, then say *tàiyángnéng* again

Before you move on

What does 太阳能 mean? ("Solar energy; solar power".) Say it once more.

518.5 dǎsǎn — to put up an umbrella

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for sunshine, then the Mandarin for solar power.

You'll want to know: dǎsǎn

dǎsǎn — "to put up an umbrella".

> *wàipó chūmén de shíhou zǒngshì dǎsǎn* — Grandma always puts up an umbrella when she goes out.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: dǎ is said with a rising tone before sǎn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎsǎn is built from 扌丁 and *sǎn* 'an umbrella', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *sanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike' and the second 'a canopy'. The vowel of dǎ is not the regular outcome of *taengX*.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎsǎn*
- *Say it: dǎsǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wàipó chūmén de shíhou zǒngshì dǎsǎn* — Grandma always puts up an umbrella when she goes out.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for sunshine, then the Mandarin for solar power, then say *dǎsǎn* again

Before you move on

What does dǎsǎn mean? ("To put up an umbrella".) Say it once more.

518.6 dàwù — thick fog

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for solar power, then the Mandarin for to put up an umbrella.

You'll want to know: dàwù

dàwù — "thick fog".

> *zǎoshang yǒu dàwù wǒmen kàn bu dào shān* — There was thick fog this morning, and we couldn't make out the hills.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dàwù is built from 大 'big' and *wù* 'fog', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dajH* and *mjuH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which explains the second, after an older book, as what comes when yin and yang are in disorder, and after another, as the earth's breath that the sky does not answer.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàwù*
- *Say it: dàwù*, once more
- *Say it: zǎoshang yǒu dàwù wǒmen kàn bu dào shān* — There was thick fog this morning, and we couldn't make out the hills.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for solar power, then the Mandarin for to put up an umbrella, then say *dàwù* again

Before you move on

What does dàwù mean? ("Thick fog".) Say it once more.

Chapter 519

Out in Nature

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about spring at its best, the early morning, a place that is mild all year, a snowy view and sitting in the cool.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 519: I can talk about spring at its best, the early morning, a place that is mild all year, a snowy view and sitting in the cool.*

519.1 春光 (chūnguāng) — the beauty of spring; spring sunshine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put up an umbrella, then the Mandarin for a thick fog.

You'll want to know: 春光

春光 — *chūnguāng* — "the beauty of spring; spring sunshine".

> 春光最好的时候树都开花了 *chūnguāng zuì hǎo de shíhou shù dōu kāihuā le* — When spring is at its loveliest, the trees are all in blossom.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

春光 (*chūnguāng*) is built from *chūn* 'spring' and 光 'light', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyhwin* and *kwang* (Guangyun, in

Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older book, as the head of the four seasons, when all things come out.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūnguāng*
- *Say it: chūnguāng*, once more
- *Say it: chūnguāng zuì hǎo de shíhou shù dōu kāihuā le* — When spring is at its loveliest, the trees are all in blossom.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put up an umbrella, then the Mandarin for a thick fog, then say *chūnguāng* again

Before you move on

What does 春光 mean? ("The beauty of spring; spring sunshine".) Say it once more.

519.2 qīngchén — early in the morning; at daybreak

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a thick fog, then the Mandarin for the beauty of spring.

You'll want to know: qīngchén

qīngchén — "early in the morning; at daybreak".

fùqīn měitiān qīngchén qù gōngyuán pǎobù — My father goes running in the park early every morning.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

qīngchén is built from *qīng* 'clear' and *chén* 'dawn', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tshjeng* and *dzyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'clear, still' and the second 'early' and 'bright'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīngchén*
- *Say it: qīngchén*, once more
- *Say it: fùqīn měitiān qīngchén qù gōngyuán pǎobù* — My father goes running in the park early every morning.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a thick fog, then the Mandarin for the beauty of spring, then say *qīngchén* again

Before you move on

What does qīngchén mean? ("Early in the morning; at daybreak".) Say it once more.

519.3 四季如春 (sìjì rú chūn) — mild like spring all year round (of a place)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the beauty of spring, then the Mandarin for early in the morning.

You'll want to know: 四季如春

四季如春 — *sìjì rú chūn* — "mild like spring all year round (of a place)".

> 这儿四季如春我最喜欢这儿的阳光 *zhèr sìjì rú chūn wǒ zuì xǐhuan zhèr de yángguāng* — It's like spring here all year round, and the sunshine is what I love most.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

四季如春 (*sìjì rú chūn*) is built from 四季 'the four seasons', 如 'like' and 春 'spring', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sijH*, *kjwijH*, *nyo* and *tsyhwin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses 如 'to resemble' and the last, after an older book, as the head of the four seasons: every season like the spring.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: sìjì rú chūn*
- *Say it: sìjì rú chūn*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr sìjì rú chūn wǒ zuì xǐhuan zhèr de yángguāng* — It's like spring here all year round, and the sunshine is what I love most.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the beauty of spring, then the Mandarin for early in the morning, then say *sìjì rú chūn* again

Before you move on

What does 四季如春 mean? ("Mild like spring all year round (of a place)".) Say it once more.

519.4 xuějǐng — a snowy landscape

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for early in the morning, then the Mandarin for like spring all year round.

You'll want to know: xuějǐng

xuějǐng — "a snowy landscape".

wǒ méi kàn guo zhème hǎokàn de xuějǐng — I've never seen such a lovely snowy landscape.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: xuě is said with a rising tone before jǐng, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xuějǐng is built from 雪 'snow' and *jǐng* 'a view', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sjwet* and *kjaengX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older book, as rain that has set, and the second 'bright' and 'an image'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xuějǐng*
- *Say it: xuějǐng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ méi kàn guo zhème hǎokàn de xuějǐng* — I've never seen such a lovely snowy landscape.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for early in the morning, then the Mandarin for like spring all year round, then say *xuějǐng* again

Before you move on

What does xuějǐng mean? ("A snowy landscape".) Say it once more.

519.5 chéngliáng — to sit in the cool (out of the sun)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for like spring all year round, then the Mandarin for a snowy landscape.

You'll want to know: chéngliáng

chéngliáng — "to sit in the cool (out of the sun)".

xiàtiān de wǎnshang dàjiā dōu zài wàibian chéngliáng — On summer evenings everyone sits outside in the cool.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chéngliáng is built from *chéng* 'to ride on' and *liáng* 'cool', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *zying* and *ljang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to drive' and 'to mount' and the second 'thin' and 'cold': to take the cool air.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngliáng*
- *Say it: chéngliáng*, once more
- *Say it: xiàtiān de wǎnshang dàjiā dōu zài wàibian chéngliáng* — On summer evenings everyone sits outside in the cool.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for like spring all year round, then the Mandarin for a snowy landscape, then say *chéngliáng* again

Before you move on

What does chéngliáng mean? ("To sit in the cool (out of the sun)".) Say it once more.

519.6 Looking back: from When the Weather Turns to Out in Nature

Say the Mandarin for a flash of lightning and to get caught in the rain.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a flash of lightning, to get caught in the rain, a thunderstorm, to be frozen stiff, to melt
- *Say it:* bitterly cold, the four seasons, the rainy season, to escape the summer heat, to bring in the harvest
- *Say it:* fallen leaves, a tree, a fruit tree, the woods, to ripen
- *Say it:* to get light at dawn, light from the sun, to give off light, starlight, twilight
- *Say it:* clear and cloudless, sunshine, solar power, to put up an umbrella, a thick fog
- *Say it:* the beauty of spring, early in the morning, like spring all year round, a snowy landscape, to sit in the cool
- *Read it:* 季 树 光 阳 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A flash of lightning? (*shǎndiàn.*) To get caught in the rain? (*línyǔ.*) A thunderstorm? (*léiyǔ.*) To be frozen stiff? (*dòngjiāng.*) To melt? (*rónghuà.*) Bitterly cold? (*hánlěng.*) The four seasons? (四季, *sìjì.*) The rainy season? (雨季, *yǔjì.*) To escape the summer heat? (*bìshǔ.*) To bring in the harvest? (*shōuhuò.*) Fallen leaves? (*luòyè.*) A tree? (树, *shù.*) A fruit tree? (果树, *guǒshù.*) The woods? (*shùlín.*) To ripen? (*chéngshú.*) To get light at dawn? (*tiānliàng.*) Light from the sun? (光, *guāng.*) To give off light? (发光, *fāguāng.*) Starlight? (星光, *xīngguāng.*) Twilight? (*huánghūn.*) Clear and cloudless? (*qínglǎng.*) Sunshine? (阳光, *yángguāng.*) Solar power? (太阳能, *tàiyángnéng.*) To put up an umbrella? (*dǎsǎn.*) A thick fog? (*dàwù.*) The beauty of spring? (春光, *chūnguāng.*) Early in the morning? (*qīngchén.*) Like spring all year round? (四季如春, *sìjì rú chūn.*) A snowy landscape? (*xuějǐng.*) To sit in the cool? (*chéngliáng.*)

Chapter 520

Around the House

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about household appliances, light switches, the water heater, the heating and saving electricity.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 520: I can talk about household appliances, light switches, the water heater, the heating and saving electricity.*

520.1 家电 (jiādiàn) — household appliance

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a snowy landscape, then the Mandarin for to sit in the cool.

You'll want to know: 家电

家电 — *jiādiàn* — "household appliance".

> 我们去年买了一些新家电 *wǒmen qùnián mǎi le yìxiē xīn jiādiàn* — We bought some new household appliances last year.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

家电 (*jiādiàn*) is built from 家 'home' and 电 'electricity', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kae* and *denH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary explains the second as the flash when yin and yang clash, lightning; the sense 'electricity' is modern.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiādiàn*
- *Say it: jiādiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen qùnián mǎi le yìxiē xīn jiādiàn* — We bought some new household appliances last year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a snowy landscape, then the Mandarin for to sit in the cool, then say *jiādiàn* again

Before you move on

What does 家电 mean? ("Household appliance".) Say it once more.

520.2 开关 (kāiguān) — a light switch; a switch on a machine

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sit in the cool, then the Mandarin for a household appliance.

You'll want to know: 开关

开关 — *kāiguān* — "a light switch; a switch on a machine".

wǒ zhǎo bu dào dēng de kāiguān — I can't find the light switch.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

开关 (*kāiguān*) is built from 开 'to open' and 关 'to close', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khoj* and *kwaen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second, after an older dictionary, as the bar laid across a door to hold it shut: the thing that opens and closes.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāiguān*
- *Say it: kāiguān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zhǎo bu dào dēng de kāiguān* — I can't find the light switch.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sit in the cool, then the Mandarin for a household appliance, then say *kāiguān* again

Before you move on

What does 开关 mean? ("A light switch; a switch on a machine".) Say it once more.

520.3 rèshuǐqì — water heater

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a household appliance, then the Mandarin for a light switch.

You'll want to know: rèshuǐqì

rèshuǐqì — "water heater".

wǒmen de rèshuǐqì yòng le shí nián le — Our water heater has been going for ten years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rèshuǐqì is built from 热 'hot', 水 'water' and *qì* 'a vessel', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyet*, *sywijX* and *khijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the last 'vessels and dishes'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: rèshuǐqì*
- *Say it: rèshuǐqì*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen de rèshuǐqì yòng le shí nián le* — Our water heater has been going for ten years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a household appliance, then the Mandarin for a light switch, then say *rèshuǐqì* again

Before you move on

What does rèshuǐqì mean? ("Water heater".) Say it once more.

520.4 nuǎnqì — central heating

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a light switch, then the Mandarin for a water heater.

You'll want to know: nuǎnqì

nuǎnqì — "central heating".

yǒu nuǎnqì de fángjiān bǐ wàibian nuǎnhuo — A room with heating is warmer than outside.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nuǎnqì is built from *nuǎn* 'warm' and 气 'air', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nwanX* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary gives the first as the same word as another spelling glossed 'the warmth of a fire', and the second 'breath'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: nuǎnqì*
- *Say it: nuǎnqì*, once more
- *Say it: yǒu nuǎnqì de fángjiān bǐ wàibian nuǎnhuo* — A room with heating is warmer than outside.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a light switch, then the Mandarin for a water heater, then say *nuǎnqì* again

Before you move on

What does nuǎnqì mean? ("Central heating".) Say it once more.

520.5 shěngdiàn — to use little electricity; to save electricity

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a water heater, then the Mandarin for central heating.

You'll want to know: shěngdiàn

shěngdiàn — "to use little electricity; to save electricity".

xīn jiādiàn bǐ jiù de shěngdiàn — New appliances use less electricity than old ones.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shěngdiàn is built from *shěng* 'to spare' and 电 'electricity', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *srjaengX* and *denH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as a government office and, under another reading, 'to examine'; the sense 'to spare, to save' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shěngdiàn*
- *Say it: shěngdiàn*, once more
- *Say it: xīn jiādiàn bǐ jiù de shěngdiàn* — New appliances use less electricity than old ones.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a water heater, then the Mandarin for central heating, then say *shěngdiàn* again

Before you move on

What does shěngdiàn mean? ("To use little electricity; to save electricity".) Say it once more.

Chapter 521

Keeping House

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about scrubbing, mending, arranging a room, keeping it tidy and keeping a kitchen clean.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 521: I can talk about scrubbing, mending, arranging a room, keeping it tidy and keeping a kitchen clean.*

521.1 shuā — to scrub; to brush clean

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for central heating, then the Mandarin for to use little electricity.

You'll want to know: shuā

shuā — "to scrub; to brush clean".

> *wǒ shuā le yí ge xiǎoshí de guō* — I spent an hour scrubbing the pot.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuā is inherited from Middle Chinese *srwaet* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to wipe clean'; the dictionary also lists *srjwet*, glossed 'to sweep'. The level tone of shuā cannot be read off *srwaet*: words that once ended in t, as this one did, are spread over all four

Mandarin tones.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuā*
- *Say it: shuā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shuā le yí ge xiǎoshí de guō* — I spent an hour scrubbing the pot.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for central heating, then the Mandarin for to use little electricity, then say *shuā* again

Before you move on

What does shuā mean? ("To scrub; to brush clean".) Say it once more.

521.2 féng — to sew; to stitch

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to use little electricity, then the Mandarin for to scrub clean.

You'll want to know: féng

féng — "to sew; to stitch".

māma bāng wǒ féng kùzi féng le bàntiān — Mum sewed up my trousers for me, and it took her ages.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

féng is inherited from Middle Chinese *bjowng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to stitch'; its departing-tone reading, *bjowngH*, is glossed 'a seam'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: féng*
- *Say it: féng*, once more
- *Say it: māma bāng wǒ féng kùzi féng le bàntiān* — Mum sewed up my trousers for me, and it took her ages.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to use little electricity, then the Mandarin for to scrub clean, then say *féng* again

Before you move on

What does féng mean? ("To sew; to stitch".) Say it once more.

521.3 bùzhì — to lay out a room; to decorate a room

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to scrub clean, then the Mandarin for to sew by hand.

You'll want to know: bùzhì

bùzhì — "to lay out a room; to decorate a room".

xīn fángzi wǒmen bùzhì le liǎng tiān — We spent two days arranging the new flat.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bùzhì is built from *bù* 'to spread' and *zhì* 'to place', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *puH* and *triH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to spread everywhere' and the second 'to set in place'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùzhì*
- *Say it: bùzhì*, once more
- *Say it: xīn fángzi wǒmen bùzhì le liǎng tiān* — We spent two days arranging the new flat.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to scrub clean, then the Mandarin for to sew by hand, then say *bùzhì* again

Before you move on

What does bùzhì mean? ("To lay out a room; to decorate a room".) Say it once more.

521.4 zhěngqí — neat; orderly

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sew by hand, then the Mandarin for to lay out a room.

You'll want to know: zhěngqí

zhěngqí — "neat; orderly".

tā de fángjiān bǐ wǒ de zhěngqí — His room is tidier than mine.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhěngqí is built from *zhěng* and *qí*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyengX* and *dzej* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses each with the other: 'upright, even'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhěngqí*
- *Say it: zhěngqí*, once more
- *Say it: tā de fángjiān bǐ wǒ de zhěngqí* — His room is tidier than mine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sew by hand, then the Mandarin for to lay out a room, then say *zhěngqí* again

Before you move on

What does zhěngqí mean? ("Neat; orderly".) Say it once more.

521.5 wèishēng — hygiene; cleanliness

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lay out a room, then the Mandarin for neat and orderly.

You'll want to know: wèishēng

wèishēng — "hygiene; cleanliness".

chúfáng yídìng yào zhùyì wèishēng — A kitchen has to be kept really clean.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wèishēng is built from *wèi* 'to guard' and 生 'life', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwejH* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to protect' and the second 'to grow'. Guarding life as a word for hygiene is modern, and its path is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wèishēng*
- *Say it: wèishēng*, once more
- *Say it: chúfáng yídìng yào zhùyì wèishēng* — A kitchen has to be kept really clean.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lay out a room, then the Mandarin for neat and orderly, then say *wèishēng* again

Before you move on

What does wèishēng mean? ("Hygiene; cleanliness".) Say it once more.

Chapter 522

Something Needs Fixing

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a leak, a repairman who comes to the house, the water bill, locks and the floor.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 522: I can talk about a leak, a repairman who comes to the house, the water bill, locks and the floor.*

522.1 lòushuǐ — to leak water

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for neat and orderly, then the Mandarin for hygiene.

You'll want to know: lòushuǐ

lòushuǐ — "to leak water".

> *chúfáng lòushuǐ yǐjīng sān tiān le* — The kitchen has been leaking for three days.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

lòushuǐ is built from *lòu* and 水 'water', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *luwH* and *sywijX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the water clock, a vessel that lets water drip away in marked steps; the sense 'to leak' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: lòushuǐ*
- *Say it: lòushuǐ*, once more
- *Say it: chúfáng lòushuǐ yǐjīng sān tiān le* — The kitchen has been leaking for three days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for neat and orderly, then the Mandarin for hygiene, then say *lòushuǐ* again

Before you move on

What does lòushuǐ mean? ("To leak water".) Say it once more.

522.2 上门 (shàngmén) — to call at the house (to do a job)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for hygiene, then the Mandarin for to leak water.

You'll want to know: 上门

上门 — *shàngmén* — "to call at the house (to do a job)".

xiū kōngtiáo de shīfu míngtiān shàngmén — The man who fixes air conditioners is coming round tomorrow.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

上门 (*shàngmén*) is built from 上 'to go up' and 门 'a door', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyangX* and *mwon* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to climb, to rise': to come up to someone's door.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shàngmén*
- *Say it: shàngmén*, once more
- *Say it: xiū kōngtiáo de shīfu míngtiān shàngmén* — The man who fixes air conditioners is coming round tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for hygiene, then the Mandarin for to leak water, then say *shàngmén* again

Before you move on

What does 上门 mean? ("To call at the house (to do a job)".) Say it once more.

522.3 shuǐfèi — water bill

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to leak water, then the Mandarin for to call at the house.

You'll want to know: shuǐfèi

shuǐfèi — "water bill".

zhège yuè de shuǐfèi bǐ shàng ge yuè guì — This month's water bill is higher than last month's.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shuǐfèi is built from 水 'water' and *fèi* 'a cost', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sywijX* and *phj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to use up, to spend'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shuǐfèi*
- *Say it: shuǐfèi*, once more
- *Say it: zhège yuè de shuǐfèi bǐ shàng ge yuè guì* — This month's water bill is higher than last month's.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to leak water, then the Mandarin for to call at the house, then say *shuǐfèi* again

Before you move on

What does shuǐfèi mean? ("Water bill".) Say it once more.

522.4 ménlíng — doorbell

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to call at the house, then the Mandarin for the water bill.

You'll want to know: ménlíng

ménlíng — "doorbell".

wǒmen jiā de ménlíng huài le sān tiān le — Our doorbell has been broken for three days.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ménlíng is built from 门 'a door' and *líng* 'a bell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mwon* and *leng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as like a bell, but smaller.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: ménlíng*
- *Say it: ménlíng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen jiā de ménlíng huài le sān tiān le* — Our doorbell has been broken for three days.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to call at the house, then the Mandarin for the water bill, then say *ménlíng* again

Before you move on

What does ménlíng mean? ("Doorbell".) Say it once more.

522.5 dìbǎn — the floor of a room; floorboards

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the water bill, then the Mandarin for a doorbell.

You'll want to know: dìbǎn

dìbǎn — "the floor of a room; floorboards".

wǒ shuā le bàntiān dìbǎn — I spent ages scrubbing the floor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dìbǎn is built from 地 'the ground' and *bǎn* 'a board', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dijH* and *paenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which gives the second as the same word as another spelling glossed, after an older dictionary, 'split wood'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dìbǎn*
- *Say it: dìbǎn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ shuā le bàntiān dìbǎn* — I spent ages scrubbing the floor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the water bill, then the Mandarin for a doorbell, then say *dìbǎn* again

Before you move on

What does dìbǎn mean? ("The floor of a room; floorboards".) Say it once more.

Chapter 523

Buying and Selling

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about running a business, sellers and buyers, and selling wholesale or retail.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 523: I can talk about running a business, sellers and buyers, and selling wholesale or retail.*

523.1 pīfā — to sell wholesale

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a doorbell, then the Mandarin for the floor of a room.

You'll want to know: pīfā

pīfā — "to sell wholesale".

> *zhè jiā shāngdiàn pīfā shuǐguǒ* — This shop sells fruit wholesale.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pīfā is built from *pī* and 发 'to send out', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *phej* and *pjot* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to strike', 'to push' and 'to pass on'; how the pair came to mean selling in bulk is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: pīfā*
- *Say it: pīfā*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā shāngdiàn pīfā shuǐguǒ* — This shop sells fruit wholesale.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a doorbell, then the Mandarin for the floor of a room, then say *pīfā* again

Before you move on

What does pīfā mean? ("To sell wholesale".) Say it once more.

523.2 买卖 (mǎimai) — buying and selling for a living; a business deal

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the floor of a room, then the Mandarin for to sell wholesale.

You'll want to know: 买卖

买卖 — *mǎimai* — "buying and selling for a living; a business deal".

他做了二十年买卖 *tā zuò le èrshí nián mǎimai* — He has made his living buying and selling for twenty years.

The new character, in pieces: 卖 — eight strokes in two pieces: 十 on top, two strokes; and 买 under it, six strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

买卖 (*mǎimai*) is built from 买 'to buy' and 卖 'to sell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *meaX* and *meaH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first, after an older dictionary, 'to

trade' and the second 'to put goods out'. The two differ only in their tones, and in the word the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎimai*
- *Say it: mǎimai*, once more
- *Say it: tā zuò le èrshí nián mǎimai* — He has made his living buying and selling for twenty years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the floor of a room, then the Mandarin for to sell wholesale, then say *mǎimai* again

Before you move on

What does 买卖 mean? ("Buying and selling for a living; a business deal".) Say it once more.

523.3 卖 — 十 on top, then 买 under it

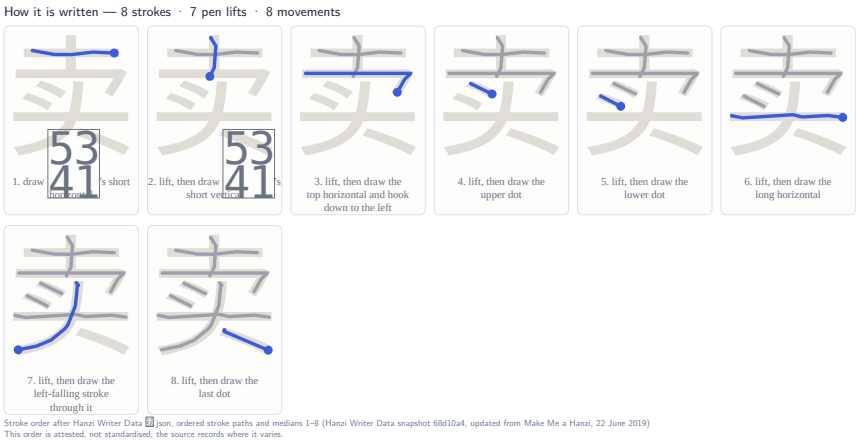
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *mǎimai* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  买 十

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *mǎi*, *shí*

Script — 十 on top, then 买 under it



How 卖 is written, stroke by stroke

卖

Two pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, 十, two strokes: a short bar, then a short vertical down through it.

The bottom piece, 买, six strokes, as you wrote it: a bar that hooks down at its right end, two short strokes falling to the right under it, a long bar, a long stroke falling to the left and a long stroke falling to the right.

2 + 6 = eight: to sell is to buy with 十 on top.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 卖, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 卖 have? (**Two: 十 and 买**.) How does 卖 differ from 买? (**It has 十 on top**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 卖, pinned stroke paths and medians.

523.4 卖家 (màijiā) — seller

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sell wholesale, then the Mandarin for buying and selling for a living.

You'll want to know: 卖家

卖家 — *màijiā* — "seller".

我觉得这个卖家最好 *wǒ juéde zhège màijiā zuì hǎo* — I think this seller is the best.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

卖家 (*màijiā*) is built from 卖 'to sell' and 家, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *meaH* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the second 'a dwelling'; its use for the one who does a trade is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: màijiā*
- *Say it: màijiā*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhège màijiā zuì hǎo* — I think this seller is the best.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sell wholesale, then the Mandarin for buying and selling for a living, then say *màijiā* again

Before you move on

What does 卖家 mean? ("Seller".) Say it once more.

523.5 买家 (mǎijiā) — buyer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for buying and selling for a living, then the Mandarin for the seller (in a sale).

You'll want to know: 买家

买家 — *mǎijiā* — "buyer".

> 买家都觉得这个卖家很好 *mǎijiā dōu juéde zhège màijiā hěn hǎo* — The buyers all think this seller is very good.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

买家 (*mǎijiā*) is built from 买 'to buy' and 家, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *meaX* and *kae* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'a dwelling'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: mǎijiā*
- *Say it: mǎijiā*, once more
- *Say it: mǎijiā dōu juéde zhège màijiā hěn hǎo* — The buyers all think this seller is very good.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for buying and selling for a living, then the Mandarin for the seller (in a sale), then say *mǎijiā* again

Before you move on

What does 买家 mean? ("Buyer".) Say it once more.

523.6 língshòu — to sell retail

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the seller (in a sale), then the Mandarin for the buyer (in a sale).

You'll want to know: língshòu

língshòu — "to sell retail".

zhè jiā shāngdiàn zhǐ língshòu bù pīfā — This shop sells only retail, not wholesale.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

língshòu is built from *líng* and *shòu* 'to sell', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *leng* and *dzyuwH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to fall' and, after an older dictionary, as a slow rain; the sense 'in small bits' is not given there. It glosses the second 'to sell goods'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: língshòu*
- *Say it: língshòu*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā shāngdiàn zhǐ língshòu bù pīfā* — This shop sells only retail, not wholesale.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the seller (in a sale), then the Mandarin for the buyer (in a sale), then say *língshòu* again

Before you move on

What does língshòu mean? ("To sell retail".) Say it once more.

Chapter 524

Half Price

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about paying the bill, half price, the asking price, offering less and the cost of living.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 524: I can talk about paying the bill, half price, the asking price, offering less and the cost of living.*

524.1 jiézhàng — to settle the bill

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the buyer (in a sale), then the Mandarin for to sell retail.

You'll want to know: jiézhàng

jiézhàng — "to settle the bill".

> *wǒmen děng le èrshí fēnzhōng cái jiézhàng* — We waited twenty minutes before we could settle the bill.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiézhàng is built from *jié* 'to tie' and *zhàng* 'an account'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *ket* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to tie'; no dictionary we use records an older form of the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiézhàng*
- *Say it: jiézhàng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen děng le èrshí fēnzhōng cái jiézhàng* — We waited twenty minutes before we could settle the bill.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the buyer (in a sale), then the Mandarin for to sell retail, then say *jiézhàng* again

Before you move on

What does jiézhàng mean? ("To settle the bill".) Say it once more.

524.2 半价 (bànjià) — half price

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to sell retail, then the Mandarin for to settle the bill.

You'll want to know: 半价

半价 — *bànjià* — "half price".

今天这儿的东西都半价 *jīntiān zhèr de dōngxi dōu bànjià* — Everything here is half price today.

The new character, in pieces: 价 — six strokes in three pieces: the person piece on the left, two strokes, as in 你; 人 on the right, two strokes; and under 人 a short stroke falling to the left and a vertical. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

半价 (*bànjià*) is built from 半 'half' and 价 'a price', the jià of the word for price, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *panH* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a

thing split in the middle and the second as the count of a price.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bànjià*
- *Say it: bànjià*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān zhèr de dōngxi dōu bànjià* — Everything here is half price today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to sell retail, then the Mandarin for to settle the bill, then say *bànjià* again

Before you move on

What does 半价 mean? ("Half price".) Say it once more.

524.3 价 — the person piece, then 人 with two legs under it

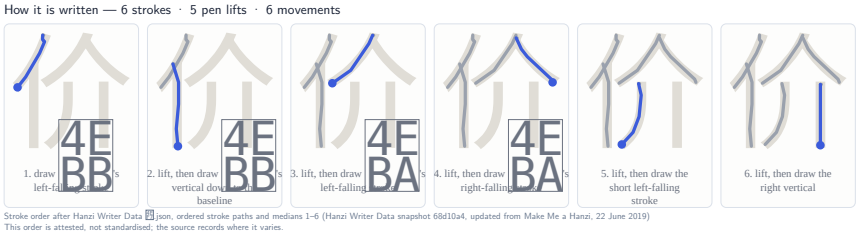
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *bànjià* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  你 人

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *nǐ*, *rén*

Script — the person piece, then 人 with two legs under it



How 价 is written, stroke by stroke

价

Three pieces: the person piece, then 人, then what stands under it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the person piece, two strokes, as in 你: a stroke falling to the left, then a vertical down to the foot.

The top right piece, 人, two strokes, as you wrote it, spread wide like a roof: a long stroke falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the right.

Under it, two strokes: a short stroke that drops and falls to the left, then a vertical on the right.

2 + 2 + 2 = six.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 价, all six, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 价 have? (**Six.**) What is the first piece? (**The person piece, on the left.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 价, pinned stroke paths and medians.

524.4 要价 (yàojià) — to name one's price; to ask a price

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to settle the bill, then the Mandarin for at half price.

You'll want to know: 要价

要价 — *yàojià* — "to name one's price; to ask a price".

tā yàojià bǐ nà jiā shāngdiàn gāo — He's asking more than that shop.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

要价 (*yàojià*) is built from 要 'to want' and 价 'a price', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jiewH* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to bind by agreement' and the second as the count of a price.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàojià*
- *Say it: yàojià*, once more
- *Say it: tā yàojià bǐ nà jiā shāngdiàn gāo* — He's asking more than that shop.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to settle the bill, then the Mandarin for at half price, then say *yàojià* again

Before you move on

What does 要价 mean? ("To name one's price; to ask a price".) Say it once more.

524.5 还价 (huánjià) — to offer a lower price back; to make a counter-offer

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for at half price, then the Mandarin for to name one's price.

You'll want to know: 还价

还价 — *huánjià* — "to offer a lower price back; to make a counter-offer".

在这儿买东西最好还价 *zài zhèr mǎi dōngxi zuìhǎo huánjià* — When you buy things here, it's best to offer less.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

还价 (*huánjià*) is built from 还 huán 'to give back' and 价 'a price', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwaen* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to return': a price handed back.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huánjià*
- *Say it: huánjià*, once more
- *Say it: zài zhèr mǎi dōngxi zuìhǎo huánjià* — When you buy things here, it's best to offer less.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for at half price, then the Mandarin for to name one's price, then say *huánjià* again

Before you move on

What does 还价 mean? ("To offer a lower price back; to make a counter-offer".) Say it once more.

524.6 wùjià — prices; the cost of living

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to name one's price, then the Mandarin for to offer a lower price back.

You'll want to know: wùjià

wùjià — "prices; the cost of living".

> *zhèr de wùjià bǐ Běijīng gāo* — The cost of living here is higher than in Beijing.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

wùjià is built from *wù* 'a thing' and 价 'a price', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjut* and *kaeH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'all things': the price of things.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: wùjià*
- *Say it: wùjià*, once more
- *Say it: zhèr de wùjià bǐ Běijīng gāo* — The cost of living here is higher than in Beijing.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to name one's price, then the Mandarin for to offer a lower price back, then say *wùjià* again

Before you move on

What does wùjià mean? ("Prices; the cost of living".) Say it once more.

Chapter 525

At Your Service

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about attentive service and shop assistants, complain and get a refund, and say something is especially good.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 525: I can talk about attentive service and shop assistants, complain and get a refund, and say something is especially good.*

525.1 zhōudào — attentive and thorough (of service)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to offer a lower price back, then the Mandarin for the cost of living.

You'll want to know: zhōudào

zhōudào — "attentive and thorough (of service)".

> *zhè jiā fàndiàn de fúwùyuán bǐ nà jiā zhōudào* — The waiters in this restaurant are more attentive than in that one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhōudào is built from *zhōu* and 到 'to reach', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuw* and *tawH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'all round', 'complete' and 'close' and the second 'to arrive': reaching all round.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhōudào*
- *Say it: zhōudào*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā fàndiàn de fúwùyuán bǐ nà jiā zhōudào* — The waiters in this restaurant are more attentive than in that one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to offer a lower price back, then the Mandarin for the cost of living, then say *zhōudào* again

Before you move on

What does zhōudào mean? ("Attentive and thorough (of service)".) Say it once more.

525.2 格外 (géwài) — more than usual; unusually

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the cost of living, then the Mandarin for attentive and thorough.

You'll want to know: 格外

格外 — *géwài* — "more than usual; unusually".

今天的菜格外好吃 *jīntiān de cài géwài hǎochī* — The food is especially good today.

The new character, in pieces: 格 — ten strokes in three pieces: on the left the tree piece, four strokes, as in 机; on the right the walking foot, three strokes, as in the middle of 客; and 口 under it, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

格外 (*géwài*) is built from 格 and 外 'outside', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaek* and *ngwajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'a pattern' and 'a measure', and lists another reading, *kak*, for a branch; outside the measure is beyond the usual, though how the pair came to mean 'especially' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: géwài*
- *Say it: géwài*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān de cài géwài hǎochī* — The food is especially good today.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the cost of living, then the Mandarin for attentive and thorough, then say *géwài* again

Before you move on

What does 格外 mean? ("More than usual; unusually".) Say it once more.

525.3 格 — the tree piece, then the walking foot over 口

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *géwài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

客 机

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kè*, *jī*

Script — the tree piece, then the walking foot over 口

How 格 *is written, stroke by stroke*

格

Three pieces: the tree piece on the left, then the walking foot, then 口 under it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The left piece, the tree piece, four strokes, narrow, as in 机: a short bar, a vertical down through it, a stroke falling to the left, then a short dot to the right.

The walking foot, three strokes, as in 客: a short stroke falling to the left, a bar that turns into a long stroke falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the right.

口, three strokes, at the foot: a vertical, a bar that turns down, and a bar closing it.

4 + 3 + 3 = ten.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 格, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 格 have? (**Three: the tree piece, the walking foot and 口.**) Which character has the same right side at its foot? (客.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 格, pinned stroke paths and medians.

525.4 shòuhuòyuán — shop assistant

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for attentive and thorough, then the Mandarin for more than usual.

You'll want to know: shòuhuòyuán

shòuhuòyuán — "shop assistant".

wǒ juéde zhèr de shòuhuòyuán zuì rèqíng — I think the shop assistants here are the friendliest.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shòuhuòyuán is built from *shòu* 'to sell', *huò* 'goods' and *yuán* 'a member of staff', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyuwH*, *xwaH* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to sell goods', the second 'wealth' and the third as the number of things; the sense 'staff' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shòuhuòyuán*
- *Say it: shòuhuòyuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ juéde zhèr de shòuhuòyuán zuì rèqíng* — I think the shop assistants here are the friendliest.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for attentive and thorough, then the Mandarin for more than usual, then say *shòuhuòyuán* again

Before you move on

What does shòuhuòyuán mean? ("Shop assistant".) Say it once more.

525.5 tóusù — to make a formal complaint

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for more than usual, then the Mandarin for a shop assistant.

You'll want to know: tóusù

tóusù — "to make a formal complaint".

wǒ tóusù guo zhè jiā shāngdiàn — I've complained about this shop before.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóusù is built from *tóu* 'to throw, to hand in' and *sù* 'to accuse', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duw* and *suH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to entrust' and 'to throw' and the second 'to bring a case' and 'to tell'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóusù*
- *Say it: tóusù*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ tóusù guo zhè jiā shāngdiàn* — I've complained about this shop before.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for more than usual, then the Mandarin for a shop assistant, then say *tóusù* again

Before you move on

What does tóusù mean? ("To make a formal complaint".) Say it once more.

525.6 tuìkuǎn — to give the money back; to refund

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a shop assistant, then the Mandarin for to make a formal complaint.

You'll want to know: tuìkuǎn

tuìkuǎn — "to give the money back; to refund".

wǒ děng le yí ge xīngqī tāmen cái tuìkuǎn — I waited a week before they gave me my money back.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuìkuǎn is built from *tuì* 'to go back' and *kuǎn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwojH* and *khwanX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to retreat' and the second 'sincere' and 'to knock'; the sense 'a sum of money' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuìkuǎn*
- *Say it: tuìkuǎn*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ děng le yí ge xīngqī tāmen cái tuìkuǎn* — I waited a week before they gave me my money back.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a shop assistant, then the Mandarin for to make a formal complaint, then say *tuìkuǎn* again

Before you move on

What does tuìkuǎn mean? ("To give the money back; to refund".) Say it once more.

525.7 Looking back: from Around the House to At Your Service

Say the Mandarin for a household appliance and a light switch.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a household appliance, a light switch, a water heater, central heating, to use little electricity
- *Say it:* to scrub clean, to sew by hand, to lay out a room, neat and orderly, hygiene
- *Say it:* to leak water, to call at the house, the water bill, a doorbell, the floor of a room
- *Say it:* to sell wholesale, buying and selling for a living, the seller (in a sale), the buyer (in a sale), to sell retail
- *Say it:* to settle the bill, at half price, to name one's price, to offer a lower price back, the cost of living
- *Say it:* attentive and thorough, more than usual, a shop assistant, to make a formal complaint, to give the money back
- *Read it:* 卖 价 格 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

A household appliance? (家电, *jiādiàn.*) A light switch? (开关, *kāiguān.*) A water heater? (*rèshuǐqì.*) Central heating? (*nuǎnqì.*) To

use little electricity? (*shěngdiàn.*) To scrub clean? (*shuā.*) To sew by hand? (*féng.*) To lay out a room? (*bùzhì.*) Neat and orderly? (*zhěngqí.*) Hygiene? (*wèishēng.*) To leak water? (*lòushuǐ.*) To call at the house? (上门, *shàngmén.*) The water bill? (*shuǐfèi.*) A doorbell? (*ménlíng.*) The floor of a room? (*dìbǎn.*) To sell wholesale? (*pīfā.*) Buying and selling for a living? (买卖, *mǎimai.*) The seller (in a sale)? (卖家, *màijiā.*) The buyer (in a sale)? (买家, *mǎijiā.*) To sell retail? (*língshòu.*) To settle the bill? (*jiézhàng.*) At half price? (半价, *bànjià.*) To name one's price? (要价, *yàojià.*) To offer a lower price back? (还价, *huánjià.*) The cost of living? (*wùjià.*) Attentive and thorough? (*zhōudào.*) More than usual? (格外, *géwài.*) A shop assistant? (*shòuhuòyuán.*) To make a formal complaint? (*tóusù.*) To give the money back? (*tuìkuǎn.*)

Chapter 526

How Heavy?

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can weigh things, talk about kilograms and weight, and say I eat or drink a lot or a little.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 526: I can weigh things, talk about kilograms and weight, and say I eat or drink a lot or a little.*

526.1 chēng — to weigh on a scale

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a formal complaint, then the Mandarin for to give the money back.

You'll want to know: chēng

chēng — "to weigh on a scale".

> *qǐng nǐ bāng wǒ chēng zhèxiē píngguǒ* — Could you weigh these apples for me?

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chēng is inherited from Middle Chinese *tsyhing* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to know light from heavy'; the dictionary also lists *tsyhingH*, glossed 'fitting' and, in a common spelling, the balance that weighs things.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: chēng*
- *Say it: chēng*, once more
- *Say it: qǐng nǐ bāng wǒ chēng zhèxiē píngguǒ* — Could you weigh these apples for me?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a formal complaint, then the Mandarin for to give the money back, then say *chēng* again

Before you move on

What does chēng mean? ("To weigh on a scale".) Say it once more.

526.2 gōngjīn — kilogram

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give the money back, then the Mandarin for to weigh on a scale.

You'll want to know: gōngjīn

gōngjīn — "kilogram".

wǒ bǐ qùnián zhòng le liǎng gōngjīn — I'm two kilos heavier than last year.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gōngjīn is built from 公 'public, standard' and *jīn*, a weight, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuwng* and *kj+n* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as sixteen ounces. The standard weight of a kilogram is a modern use.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gōngjīn*
- *Say it: gōngjīn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bǐ qùnián zhòng le liǎng gōngjīn* — I'm two kilos heavier than last year.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give the money back, then the Mandarin for to weigh on a scale, then say *gōngjīn* again

Before you move on

What does gōngjīn mean? ("Kilogram".) Say it once more.

526.3 重量 (zhòngliàng) — weight; how heavy something is

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to weigh on a scale, then the Mandarin for a kilogram.

You'll want to know: 重量

重量 — *zhòngliàng* — "weight; how heavy something is".

zhège xiāngzi de zhòngliàng shì èrshí gōngjīn — This suitcase weighs twenty kilos.

The new character, in pieces: 量 — twelve strokes in three pieces: 日 on top, four strokes; a long bar under it; and 里 at the foot, seven strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

重量 (*zhòngliàng*) is built from 重 'heavy' and *liàng* 'an amount', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *drjowngX* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'much, thick' and gives

the second as units of dry measure. The dictionary lists the second again as *ljang*, 'to measure', the liáng of the word for talking things over.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòngliàng*
- *Say it: zhòngliàng*, once more
- *Say it: zhège xiāngzi de zhòngliàng shì èrshí gōngjīn* — This suitcase weighs twenty kilos.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to weigh on a scale, then the Mandarin for a kilogram, then say *zhòngliàng* again

Before you move on

What does 重量 mean? ("Weight; how heavy something is".) Say it once more.

526.4 量 — 日, a long bar, then 里

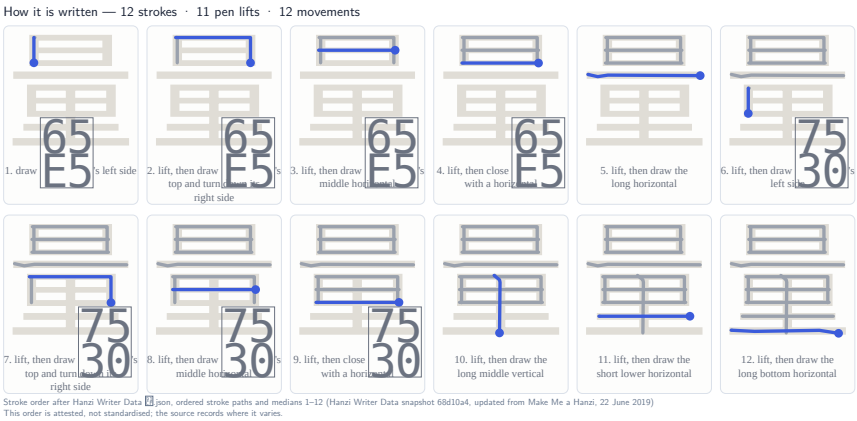
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *zhòngliàng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  里 日

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *lǐ*, *rì*

Script — 日, a long bar, then 里



How 量 *is written, stroke by stroke*

量

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, 日, four strokes, small, as you wrote it: a vertical, a bar that turns down, a bar across the middle, a bar closing the foot.

One long bar across the middle, the widest stroke of the character.

The bottom piece, 里, seven strokes, as you wrote it: a vertical, a bar that turns down, a bar across the middle, a bar closing the box, a vertical down through the middle, a short bar, then the long bar at the foot.

4 + 1 + 7 = twelve.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 量, all twelve, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 量 have? (**Three: 日, a long bar and 里.**)
How many strokes? (**Twelve.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 量, pinned stroke paths and medians.

526.5 大量 (dàliàng) — a large amount of; in large amounts

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a kilogram, then the Mandarin for how heavy something is.

You'll want to know: 大量

大量 — *dàliàng* — "a large amount of; in large amounts".

今天格外热最好大量喝水 *jīntiān géwài rè zuìhǎo dàliàng hē shuǐ* — It's especially hot today, so you'd better drink plenty of water.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

大量 (*dàliàng*) is built from 大 'big' and 量 'an amount', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dajH* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which gives the second as units of dry measure.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: dàliàng*
- *Say it: dàliàng*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān géwài rè zuìhǎo dàliàng hē shuǐ* — It's especially hot today, so you'd better drink plenty of water.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a kilogram, then the Mandarin for how heavy something is, then say *dàliàng* again

Before you move on

What does 大量 mean? ("A large amount of; in large amounts".) Say it once more.

526.6 少量 (shǎoliàng) — a small amount of

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how heavy something is, then the Mandarin for in large amounts.

You'll want to know: 少量

少量 — *shǎoliàng* — "a small amount of".

> 吃了少量的米饭以后我感觉很好 *chī le shǎoliàng de mǐfàn yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn hǎo* — After a little rice I felt fine.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

少量 (*shǎoliàng*) is built from 少 'few' and 量 'an amount', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syewX* and *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'not many'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: shǎoliàng*
- *Say it: shǎoliàng*, once more
- *Say it: chī le shǎoliàng de mǐfàn yǐhòu wǒ gǎnjué hěn hǎo* — After a little rice I felt fine.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how heavy something is, then the Mandarin for in large amounts, then say *shǎoliàng* again

Before you move on

What does 少量 mean? ("A small amount of".) Say it once more.

Chapter 527

Ordering Online

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about placing an order, packaging, being a member, special deals and checked patterns.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 527: I can talk about placing an order, packaging, being a member, special deals and checked patterns.*

527.1 xiàdān — to place an order

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in large amounts, then the Mandarin for a small amount of.

You'll want to know: xiàdān

xiàdān — "to place an order".

> *wǒ xiàdān yǐjīng sān tiān le dōngxi hái méi dào* — I placed the order three days ago, and it still hasn't arrived.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàdān is built from 下 'to put down' and *dān* 'a slip of paper', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haeX* and *tan* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to go down' and the second 'single'; the sense 'an order slip' is modern.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàdān*
- *Say it: xiàdān*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xiàdān yǐjīng sān tiān le dōngxi hái méi dào* — I placed the order three days ago, and it still hasn't arrived.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in large amounts, then the Mandarin for a small amount of, then say *xiàdān* again

Before you move on

What does xiàdān mean? ("To place an order".) Say it once more.

527.2 bāozhuāng — to wrap goods for sale

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a small amount of, then the Mandarin for to place an order.

You'll want to know: bāozhuāng

bāozhuāng — "to wrap goods for sale".

zhè jiā shāngdiàn de dōngxi bāozhuāng de zuì hǎokàn — This shop packages its things the most beautifully.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bāozhuāng is built from 包 'to wrap' and *zhuāng* 'to pack', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *paew* and *tsrjang* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to wrap up' and the second 'to bind up, to dress'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāozhuāng*
- *Say it: bāozhuāng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè jiā shāngdiàn de dōngxi bāozhuāng de zuì hǎokàn* — This shop packages its things the most beautifully.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a small amount of, then the Mandarin for to place an order, then say *bāozhuāng* again

Before you move on

What does bāozhuāng mean? ("To wrap goods for sale".) Say it once more.

527.3 huìyuán — a member of a club or a shop's scheme

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to place an order, then the Mandarin for to wrap goods for sale.

You'll want to know: huìyuán

huìyuán — "a member of a club or a shop's scheme".

wǒ dāng le sān nián huìyuán — I've been a member for three years.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

huìyuán is built from 会 'to meet' and *yuán*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwajH* and *hjwen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to come together' and the second as the number of things; the sense 'a member' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: huìyuán*
- *Say it: huìyuán*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ dāng le sān nián huìyuán* — I've been a member for three years.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to place an order, then the Mandarin for to wrap goods for sale, then say *huìyuán* again

Before you move on

What does huìyuán mean? ("A member of a club or a shop's scheme".) Say it once more.

527.4 yōuhuì — a favourable deal (for customers)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to wrap goods for sale, then the Mandarin for a member of a club.

You'll want to know: yōuhuì

yōuhuì — "a favourable deal (for customers)".

huìyuán yǒu yōuhuì — Members get a special deal.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yōuhuì is built from *yōu* and *huì*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *'juw* and *hwejH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'plentiful' and the second 'kindness'.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: yōuhuì*
- *Say it: yōuhuì*, once more
- *Say it: huìyuán yǒu yōuhuì* — Members get a special deal.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to wrap goods for sale, then the Mandarin for a member of a club, then say *yōuhuì* again

Before you move on

What does yōuhuì mean? ("A favourable deal (for customers)".) Say it once more.

527.5 格子 (gézi) — a checked pattern; squares

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a member of a club, then the Mandarin for a favourable deal.

You'll want to know: 格子

格子 — *gézi* — "a checked pattern; squares".

wǒ zuì xǐhuan zhè tiáo gézi qúnzi — This checked skirt is my favourite.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

格子 (*gézi*) is built from 格 'a pattern' and 子, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaek* and *tsiX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the second is said light, as at the end of many names of things.

What you've built

One more word for saying how it was.

Your turn

- *Say it: gézi*
- *Say it: gézi*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ zuì xǐhuan zhè tiáo gézi qúnzi* — This checked skirt is my favourite.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a member of a club, then the Mandarin for a favourable deal, then say *gézi* again

Before you move on

What does 格子 mean? ("A checked pattern; squares".) Say it once more.

Chapter 528

By Chance

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say something happens by chance, that I have no choice, and talk about drawing lots and making bets.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 528: I can say something happens by chance, that I have no choice, and talk about drawing lots and making bets.*

528.1 pèngqiǎo — as luck would have it; coincidentally

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a favourable deal, then the Mandarin for a checked pattern.

You'll want to know: pèngqiǎo

pèngqiǎo — "as luck would have it; coincidentally".

> *yàoshi pèngqiǎo lùguò jiù lái wǒ jiā zuòzuò* — If you happen to be passing, come round to my place.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pèngqiǎo is built from *pèng* 'to bump into' and *qiǎo*. No dictionary we use records an older form of the first, so its history is not settled. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *khaewX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'fine' and 'skilful'; the sense 'by coincidence' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: pèngqiǎo*
- *Say it: pèngqiǎo*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi pèngqiǎo lùguò jiù lái wǒ jiā zuòzuò* — If you happen to be passing, come round to my place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a favourable deal, then the Mandarin for a checked pattern, then say *pèngqiǎo* again

Before you move on

What does pèngqiǎo mean? ("As luck would have it; coincidentally".) Say it once more.

528.2 不得不 (bùdébù) — to be obliged to; cannot help but

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a checked pattern, then the Mandarin for as luck would have it.

You'll want to know: 不得不

不得不 — *bùdébù* — "to be obliged to; cannot help but".

如果明天下雨我们就不得不改期 *rúguǒ míngtiān xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù bùdébù gǎiqī* — If it rains tomorrow, we'll have to change the date.

Tone: the first 不 keeps its falling tone before dé; the second is said bú before a falling tone (bùdébú qù) and bù before the others.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

不得不 (*bùdébù*) is built from 不 'not', 得 'to get' and 不 again, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut*, *tok* and *pjut* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): may not not do it.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: bùdébù*
- *Say it: bùdébù*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ míngtiān xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù bùdébù gǎiqī* — If it rains tomorrow, we'll have to change the date.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a checked pattern, then the Mandarin for as luck would have it, then say *bùdébù* again

Before you move on

What does 不得不 mean? ("To be obliged to; cannot help but".) Say it once more.

528.3 chōuqiān — to draw lots

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as luck would have it, then the Mandarin for to be obliged to.

You'll want to know: chōuqiān

chōuqiān — "to draw lots".

yàoshi dàjiā dōu xiǎng qù wǒmen jiù chōuqiān — If everyone wants to go, let's draw lots.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chōuqiān is built from *chōu* 'to pull out' and *qiān*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trhjuw* and *tshjem* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to draw out' and the second, after an older dictionary, 'a test' and 'pointed'; the slip that is drawn is not named there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chōuqiān*
- *Say it: chōuqiān*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi dàjiā dōu xiǎng qù wǒmen jiù chōuqiān* — If everyone wants to go, let's draw lots.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as luck would have it, then the Mandarin for to be obliged to, then say *chōuqiān* again

Before you move on

What does chōuqiān mean? ("To draw lots".) Say it once more.

528.4 dǎdǔ — to make a bet

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be obliged to, then the Mandarin for to draw lots.

You'll want to know: dǎdǔ

dǎdǔ — "to make a bet".

wǒ gēn nǐ dǎdǔ tā míngtiān bú huì lái — I bet you he won't come tomorrow.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: dǎ is said with a rising tone before dǔ, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎdǔ is built from 打 and *dǔ* 'to gamble', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *taengX* and *tuX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to strike' and the second as gambling for play. The vowel of dǎ is not the regular outcome of *taengX*.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎdǔ*
- *Say it: dǎdǔ*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ gēn nǐ dǎdǔ tā míngtiān bú huì lái* — I bet you he won't come tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be obliged to, then the Mandarin for to draw lots, then say *dǎdǔ* again

Before you move on

What does dǎdǔ mean? ("To make a bet".) Say it once more.

528.5 ǒurán — accidental; happening by chance

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to draw lots, then the Mandarin for to make a bet.

You'll want to know: ǒurán

ǒurán — "accidental; happening by chance".

rúguǒ zhǐ fāshēng yí cì kěnéng shì ǒurán — If it only happens once, it may be chance.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

ǒurán is built from *ǒu* and 然 'so', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nguwH* and *nyen* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses *nguwH* 'unexpected', and lists a rising-tone reading, *nguwX*, glossed 'a pair'; the rising tone of ǒu matches that other reading.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: ǒurán*
- *Say it: ǒurán*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ zhǐ fāshēng yí cì kěnéng shì ǒurán* — If it only happens once, it may be chance.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to draw lots, then the Mandarin for to make a bet, then say *ǒurán* again

Before you move on

What does ǒurán mean? ("Accidental; happening by chance".) Say it once more.

Chapter 529

Good Luck, Bad Luck

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about luck, being lucky or unlucky, being in luck and fate.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 529: I can talk about luck, being lucky or unlucky, being in luck and fate.*

529.1 dǎoméi — to be out of luck; to have bad luck

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make a bet, then the Mandarin for happening by chance.

You'll want to know: dǎoméi

dǎoméi — "to be out of luck; to have bad luck".

> *jīntiān zhēn dǎoméi wǒ de qiánbāo bú jiàn le* — What bad luck today: my wallet's gone.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎoméi is built from *dǎo* 'to fall over' and *méi* 'mould'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to fall flat'; no dictionary we use records an

older form of the second, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎoméi*
- *Say it: dǎoméi*, once more
- *Say it: jīntiān zhēn dǎoméi wǒ de qiánbāo bú jiàn le* — What bad luck today: my wallet's gone.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make a bet, then the Mandarin for happening by chance, then say *dǎoméi* again

Before you move on

What does dǎoméi mean? ("To be out of luck; to have bad luck".) Say it once more.

529.2 运气 (yùnqi) — a person's luck (good or bad)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for happening by chance, then the Mandarin for to be out of luck.

You'll want to know: 运气

运气 — *yùnqi* — "a person's luck (good or bad)".

> 运气好的话我们就能买到票 *yùnqi hǎo dehuà wǒmen jiù néng mǎi dào piào* — With luck, we'll be able to get tickets.

The new character, in pieces: 运 — seven strokes in two pieces: 云 first, four strokes; then the walking piece, three strokes, as in 这, along the left and the foot. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

运气 (*yùnqi*) is built from 运 and 气 'breath', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjunH* and *khj+jH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'far', 'to move' and 'to carry'. The sense 'luck' is not given there; the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yùnqi*
- *Say it: yùnqi*, once more
- *Say it: yùnqi hǎo dehuà wǒmen jiù néng mǎi dào piào* — With luck, we'll be able to get tickets.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for happening by chance, then the Mandarin for to be out of luck, then say *yùnqi* again

Before you move on

What does 运气 mean? ("A person's luck (good or bad)".) Say it once more.

529.3 运 — 云 first, then the walking piece

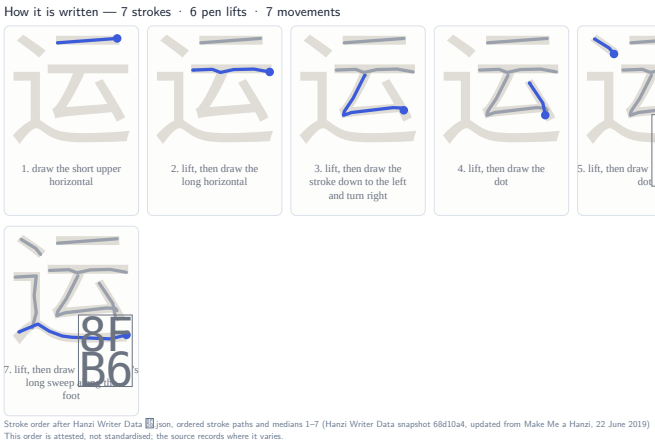
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yùnqi* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  云 这

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yún*, *zhè*

Script — 云 first, then the walking piece



How 运 is written, stroke by stroke

运

Two pieces, and the walking piece comes last, though it runs up the left and along the foot. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The inside piece, 云, four strokes, as you wrote it: a short bar, a longer bar, a stroke that falls to the left and turns right along the bottom, then a dot.

The walking piece, three strokes, as in 这: a dot, a stroke that zigzags down, then a long sweep along the foot to the right.

4 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 运, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 运 have? (**Two: 云 and the walking piece**.) Which is written first? (云.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 运, pinned stroke paths and medians.

529.4 走运 (zǒuyùn) — to be in luck

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be out of luck, then the Mandarin for a person's luck.

You'll want to know: 走运

走运 — *zǒuyùn* — "to be in luck".

如果你走运就能找到好工作 *rúguǒ nǐ zǒuyùn jiù néng zhǎo dào hǎo gōngzuò* — If you're in luck, you'll find a good job.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

走运 (*zǒuyùn*) is built from 走 'to go' and 运 'luck', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsuwX* and *hjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hurry'; the sense 'luck' of the second is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zǒuyùn*
- *Say it: zǒuyùn*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ zǒuyùn jiù néng zhǎo dào hǎo gōngzuò* — If you're in luck, you'll find a good job.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be out of luck, then the Mandarin for a person's luck, then say *zǒuyùn* again

Before you move on

What does 走运 mean? ("To be in luck".) Say it once more.

529.5 xìngyùn — lucky; fortunate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a person's luck, then the Mandarin for to be in luck.

You'll want to know: xìngyùn

xìngyùn — "lucky; fortunate".

> *wǒ hěn xìngyùn bùrán wǒ jiù chídào le* — I was lucky, or I'd have been late.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xìngyùn is built from *xìng* and 运 'luck', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *heangX* and *hjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first, after an older book, as having good fortune and escaping harm.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: xìngyùn*
- *Say it: xìngyùn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ hěn xìngyùn bùrán wǒ jiù chídào le* — I was lucky, or I'd have been late.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a person's luck, then the Mandarin for to be in luck, then say *xìngyùn* again

Before you move on

What does xìngyùn mean? ("Lucky; fortunate".) Say it once more.

529.6 mìngyùn — fate; destiny

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be in luck, then the Mandarin for fortunate.

You'll want to know: mìngyùn

mìngyùn — "fate; destiny".

> *jíshǐ mìngyùn bù hǎo wǒmen yě yào nǔlì* — Even if fate is against us, we have to keep trying.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mìngyùn is built from *mìng* and 运 'luck', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjaengH* and *hjunH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to order' and 'to send': what has been ordered for you.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: mìngyùn*
- *Say it: mìngyùn*, once more
- *Say it: jíshǐ mìngyùn bù hǎo wǒmen yě yào nǔlì* — Even if fate is against us, we have to keep trying.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be in luck, then the Mandarin for fortunate, then say *mìngyùn* again

Before you move on

What does mìngyùn mean? ("Fate; destiny".) Say it once more.

Chapter 530

Winning a Prize

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about lottery tickets, prize draws, winning a prize and trying my luck.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 530: I can talk about lottery tickets, prize draws, winning a prize and trying my luck.*

530.1 cǎipiào — lottery ticket

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fortunate, then the Mandarin for fate.

You'll want to know: cǎipiào

cǎipiào — "lottery ticket".

> *tā měi ge xīngqī dōu mǎi cǎipiào* — He buys lottery tickets every week.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cǎipiào is built from *cǎi* and 票 'a ticket'. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *tshojX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'brilliant colour'; no dictionary we use records an older form of 票, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: cǎipiào*
- *Say it: cǎipiào*, once more
- *Say it: tā měi ge xīngqī dōu mǎi cǎipiào* — He buys lottery tickets every week.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fortunate, then the Mandarin for fate, then say *cǎipiào* again

Before you move on

What does cǎipiào mean? ("Lottery ticket".) Say it once more.

530.2 chōujiǎng — to draw for prizes; to hold a prize draw

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fate, then the Mandarin for a lottery ticket.

You'll want to know: chōujiǎng

chōujiǎng — "to draw for prizes; to hold a prize draw".

zhǐyào mǎi yìbǎi kuài qián de dōngxi jiù kěyǐ chōujiǎng — Spend a hundred yuan and you can enter the prize draw.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chōujiǎng is built from *chōu* 'to pull out' and *jiǎng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trhjuw* and *tsjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to encourage' and 'to praise'; the sense 'a prize' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chōujiǎng*
- *Say it: chōujiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào mǎi yìbǎi kuài qián de dōngxi jiù kěyǐ chōujiǎng* — Spend a hundred yuan and you can enter the prize draw.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fate, then the Mandarin for a lottery ticket, then say *chōujiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does chōujiǎng mean? ("To draw for prizes; to hold a prize draw".) Say it once more.

530.3 zhòngjiǎng — to win in a draw; to win a prize

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a lottery ticket, then the Mandarin for to draw for prizes.

You'll want to know: zhòngjiǎng

zhòngjiǎng — "to win in a draw; to win a prize".

yàoshi wǒ zhòngjiǎng le wǒ jiù qù lǚyóu — If I win a prize, I'll go travelling.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhòngjiǎng is built from 中 zhòng 'to hit the mark' and *jiǎng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *trjuwngH* and *tsjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to hit' and the second 'to encourage'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhòngjiǎng*
- *Say it: zhòngjiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi wǒ zhòngjiǎng le wǒ jiù qù lǚyóu* — If I win a prize, I'll go travelling.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a lottery ticket, then the Mandarin for to draw for prizes, then say *zhòngjiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does zhòngjiǎng mean? ("To win in a draw; to win a prize".) Say it once more.

530.4 jiǎngpǐn — a prize you win; an award

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to draw for prizes, then the Mandarin for to win in a draw.

You'll want to know: jiǎngpǐn

jiǎngpǐn — "a prize you win; an award".

rúguǒ nǐ zhòngjiǎng le jiù kěyǐ ná dào jiǎngpǐn — If you win, you'll get a prize.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: jiǎng is said with a rising tone before pǐn, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎngpǐn is built from *jiǎng* and *pǐn*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsjangX* and *phimX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to encourage' and the second 'a rank' and 'a

kind'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎngpǐn*
- *Say it: jiǎngpǐn*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ zhòngjiǎng le jiù kěyǐ ná dào jiǎngpǐn* — If you win, you'll get a prize.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to draw for prizes, then the Mandarin for to win in a draw, then say *jiǎngpǐn* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎngpǐn mean? ("A prize you win; an award".) Say it once more.

530.5 tóujiǎng — first prize; the jackpot

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to win in a draw, then the Mandarin for a prize you win.

You'll want to know: tóujiǎng

tóujiǎng — "first prize; the jackpot".

zhè cì chōujiǎng de tóujiǎng shì yìbǎi wàn — The first prize in this draw is a million.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tóujiǎng is built from 头 'the head' and *jiǎng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *duw* and *tsjangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to encourage': the reward at

the head of the list.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: tóujiǎng*
- *Say it: tóujiǎng*, once more
- *Say it: zhè cì chōujiǎng de tóujiǎng shì yìbǎi wàn* — The first prize in this draw is a million.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to win in a draw, then the Mandarin for a prize you win, then say *tóujiǎng* again

Before you move on

What does tóujiǎng mean? ("First prize; the jackpot".) Say it once more.

Chapter 531

A Lucky Escape

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say it is a good thing that, all but, by a fluke and unfortunately, and talk about losing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 531: I can say it is a good thing that, all but, by a fluke and unfortunately, and talk about losing.*

531.1 tuōxiǎn — to get out of danger

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a prize you win, then the Mandarin for the jackpot.

You'll want to know: tuōxiǎn

tuōxiǎn — "to get out of danger".

> *zhǐyào zhǎo dào lù wǒmen jiù néng tuōxiǎn* — As long as we find the way, we'll get out of danger.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

tuōxiǎn is built from *tuō* and *xiǎn* 'danger', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *thwat* and *xjemX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as bone with the flesh taken off, and the second 'dangerous' and 'hard'; the sense 'to slip free' is not given for the first.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuōxiǎn*
- *Say it: tuōxiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào zhǎo dào lù wǒmen jiù néng tuōxiǎn* — As long as we find the way, we'll get out of danger.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a prize you win, then the Mandarin for the jackpot, then say *tuōxiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does tuōxiǎn mean? ("To get out of danger".) Say it once more.

531.2 jīhū — very nearly; all but

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the jackpot, then the Mandarin for to get out of danger.

You'll want to know: jīhū

jīhū — "very nearly; all but".

rúguǒ xiàyǔ gōngyuán lǐ jīhū méiyǒu rén — If it rains, there's hardly anyone in the park.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jīhū is built from *jī* and *hū*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kj+j* and *hu* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary lists the first four times: *kj+j*, which gives jī, in a phrase meaning 'very nearly', and *gj+j*, glossed 'near'. It glosses the second as a grammar word; the level tone of hū is not the regular outcome of *hu*, which would give hú.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīhū*
- *Say it: jīhū*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ xiàyǔ gōngyuán lǐ jīhū méiyǒu rén* — If it rains, there's hardly anyone in the park.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the jackpot, then the Mandarin for to get out of danger, then say *jīhū* again

Before you move on

What does jīhū mean? ("Very nearly; all but".) Say it once more.

531.3 jiǎoxìng — lucky by a fluke

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get out of danger, then the Mandarin for all but.

You'll want to know: jiǎoxìng

jiǎoxìng — "lucky by a fluke".

wǒmen zhè cì méi chūshì zhǐ shì jiǎoxìng — Nothing happened to us this time, but it was only a fluke.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jiǎoxìng is built from *jiǎo* and *xìng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kewX* and *heangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary reads the first character as written today *ngew*, the name of a far country, and lists the word itself, in an older spelling, under its second syllable; the first syllable of that spelling, *kewX*, regularly gives jiǎo.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎoxìng*
- *Say it: jiǎoxìng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zhè cì méi chūshì zhǐ shì jiǎoxìng* — Nothing happened to us this time, but it was only a fluke.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get out of danger, then the Mandarin for all but, then say *jiǎoxìng* again

Before you move on

What does jiǎoxìng mean? ("Lucky by a fluke".) Say it once more.

531.4 búxìng — misfortune; unfortunate

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for all but, then the Mandarin for lucky by a fluke.

You'll want to know: búxìng

búxìng — "misfortune; unfortunate".

jíshǐ yùdào búxìng yě búyào fàngqì — Even if misfortune comes your way, don't give up.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Tone: 不 is said bú before the falling tone of xìng, and the spelling shows it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

búxìng is built from 不 'not' and *xìng* 'fortunate', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pjut* and *heangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as having good fortune and escaping harm.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: búxìng*
- *Say it: búxìng*, once more
- *Say it: jíshǐ yùdào búxìng yě búyào fàngqì* — Even if misfortune comes your way, don't give up.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for all but, then the Mandarin for lucky by a fluke, then say *búxìng* again

Before you move on

What does búxìng mean? ("Misfortune; unfortunate".) Say it once more.

531.5 shīshǒu — to lose one's grip; to do by a slip of the hand

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for lucky by a fluke, then the Mandarin for a misfortune.

You'll want to know: shīshǒu

shīshǒu — "to lose one's grip; to do by a slip of the hand".

> *yàoshi nǐ shīshǒu dǎpò le bēizi jiù zài mǎi yí ge* — If your hand slips and you break a cup, buy another one.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

shīshǒu is built from *shī* 'to lose' and 手 'the hand', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *syit* and *syuwX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a mistake' and 'to let go': the hand lets it go.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: shīshǒu*
- *Say it: shīshǒu*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ shīshǒu dǎpò le bēizi jiù zài mǎi yí ge* — If your hand slips and you break a cup, buy another one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for lucky by a fluke, then the Mandarin for a misfortune, then say *shīshǒu* again

Before you move on

What does shīshǒu mean? ("To lose one's grip; to do by a slip of the hand".) Say it once more.

531.6 Looking back: from How Heavy? to A Lucky Escape

Say the Mandarin for to weigh on a scale and a kilogram.

Your turn

- *Say it:* to weigh on a scale, a kilogram, how heavy something is, in large amounts, a small amount of
- *Say it:* to place an order, to wrap goods for sale, a member of a club, a favourable deal, a checked pattern
- *Say it:* as luck would have it, to be obliged to, to draw lots, to make a bet, happening by chance
- *Say it:* to be out of luck, a person's luck, to be in luck, fortunate, fate
- *Say it:* a lottery ticket, to draw for prizes, to win in a draw, a prize you win, the jackpot

- *Say it:* to get out of danger, all but, lucky by a fluke, a misfortune, to lose one's grip
- *Read it:* 量 运 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

To weigh on a scale? (*chēng.*) A kilogram? (*gōngjīn.*) How heavy something is? (重量, *zhòngliàng.*) In large amounts? (大量, *dàliàng.*) A small amount of? (少量, *shǎoliàng.*) To place an order? (*xiàdān.*) To wrap goods for sale? (*bāozhuāng.*) A member of a club? (*huìyuán.*) A favourable deal? (*yōuhuì.*) A checked pattern? (格子, *gézi.*) As luck would have it? (*pèngqiǎo.*) To be obliged to? (不得不, *bùdébù.*) To draw lots? (*chōuqiān.*) To make a bet? (*dǎdǔ.*) Happening by chance? (*ǒurán.*) To be out of luck? (*dǎoméi.*) A person's luck? (运气, *yùnqi.*) To be in luck? (走运, *zǒuyùn.*) Fortunate? (*xìngyùn.*) Fate? (*mìngyùn.*) A lottery ticket? (*cǎipiào.*) To draw for prizes? (*chōujiǎng.*) To win in a draw? (*zhòngjiǎng.*) A prize you win? (*jiǎngpǐn.*) The jackpot? (*tóujiǎng.*) To get out of danger? (*tuōxiǎn.*) All but? (*jīhū.*) Lucky by a fluke? (*jiǎoxìng.*) A misfortune? (*búxìng.*) To lose one's grip? (*shīshǒu.*)

Chapter 532

Hoping for More

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I'm dying for something, that something should happen, what I expect and whom I count on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 532: I can say I'm dying for something, that something should happen, what I expect and whom I count on.*

532.1 有望 (yǒuwàng) — with good hopes of it; likely to happen

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a misfortune, then the Mandarin for to lose one's grip.

You'll want to know: 有望

有望 — *yǒuwàng* — "with good hopes of it; likely to happen".

> 如果天气好飞机就有望正点起飞 *rúguǒ tiānqì hǎo fēijī jiù yǒuwàng zhèngdiǎn qǐfēi* — If the weather is good, the plane should take off on time.

The new character, in pieces: 望 — eleven strokes in three pieces: on the top left a dot, a bar and a short vertical that turns right, three strokes; on the top right 月, four strokes; and 王 at the foot, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

有望 (*yǒuwàng*) is built from 有 'to have' and *wàng*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjuwX* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to look out for' and, after an older dictionary, as watching for someone far away to come back.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yǒuwàng*
- *Say it: yǒuwàng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ tiānqì hǎo fēijī jiù yǒuwàng zhèngdiǎn qǐfēi* — If the weather is good, the plane should take off on time.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a misfortune, then the Mandarin for to lose one's grip, then say *yǒuwàng* again

Before you move on

What does 有望 mean? ("With good hopes of it; likely to happen".) Say it once more.

532.2 望 — a small piece and 月, then 王 under them

The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yǒuwàng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  月 王

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yuè*, *wáng*

Script — a small piece and 月, then 王 under them

How 望 *is written, stroke by stroke*

望

Three pieces: two side by side on top, then one across the foot. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top left piece, three strokes: a dot, a bar under it, then a short vertical that turns right along the bottom.

The top right piece, 月, four strokes, as you wrote it: a stroke down that falls to the left, a bar that turns down and hooks, then two short bars inside.

The bottom piece, 王, four strokes, as you wrote it: a bar, a second bar, a vertical down through them, then the long bar at the foot.

3 + 4 + 4 = eleven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 望, all eleven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 望 have? (**Three**.) Which two have you written before? (月 **and** 王.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 望, pinned stroke paths and medians.

532.3 bābude — to be dying to; to be eager for (colloquial)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to lose one's grip, then the Mandarin for with good hopes of it.

You'll want to know: bābude

bābude — "to be dying to; to be eager for (colloquial)".

wǒ bābude mǎshàng fàngjià — I'm dying for the holidays to start right away.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.
Tone: 不 and 得 are both said light here, bābude, so 不 does not change its tone.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

bābude is built from *bā*, 不 'not' and 得, all inherited from Middle Chinese, *pae*, *pjut* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as the name of a region in the west and of a creature; the sense 'to long for' is not given there, and how the three came to mean 'to be dying to' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: bābude*
- *Say it: bābude*, once more

- *Say it: wǒ bābude mǎshàng fàngjià* — I'm dying for the holidays to start right away.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to lose one's grip, then the Mandarin for with good hopes of it, then say *bābude* again

Before you move on

What does bābude mean? ("To be dying to; to be eager for (colloquial)".) Say it once more.

532.4 期望 (qīwàng) — to expect much of someone; expectations

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for with good hopes of it, then the Mandarin for to be dying to.

You'll want to know: 期望

期望 — *qīwàng* — "to expect much of someone; expectations".

yàoshi nǐ qīwàng tài gāo jiù huì shīwàng — If you expect too much, you'll be disappointed.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

期望 (*qīwàng*) is built from 期 'a set time' and 望 'to look out for', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *gi* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a time agreed on'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qīwàng*
- *Say it: qīwàng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ qīwàng tài gāo jiù huì shīwàng* — If you expect too much, you'll be disappointed.

- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for with good hopes of it, then the Mandarin for to be dying to, then say *qīwàng* again

Before you move on

What does 期望 mean? ("To expect much of someone; expectations".) Say it once more.

532.5 如意 (rúyì) — as one would wish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be dying to, then the Mandarin for to expect much of someone.

You'll want to know: 如意

如意 — *rúyì* — "as one would wish".

rúguǒ gōngzuò bú tài rúyì jiù huàn yí ge — If your job isn't quite what you hoped, change it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

如意 (*rúyì*) is built from 如 'like' and 意 'what one means', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyo* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'intent': as one intends.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: rúyì*
- *Say it: rúyì*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ gōngzuò bú tài rúyì jiù huàn yí ge* — If your job isn't quite what you hoped, change it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be dying to, then the Mandarin for to expect much of someone, then say *rúyì* again

Before you move on

What does 如意 mean? ("As one would wish".) Say it once more.

532.6 zhǐwàng — to count on someone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to expect much of someone, then the Mandarin for as one would wish it.

You'll want to know: zhǐwàng

zhǐwàng — "to count on someone".

nǐ búyào zhǐwàng tā bùrán nǐ huì shīwàng — Don't count on him, or you'll be disappointed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǐwàng is built from *zhǐ* 'to point to' and 望 'to look out for', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyijX* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'a finger' and 'to show'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǐwàng*
- *Say it: zhǐwàng*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ búyào zhǐwàng tā bùrán nǐ huì shīwàng* — Don't count on him, or you'll be disappointed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to expect much of someone, then the Mandarin for as one would wish it, then say *zhǐwàng* again

Before you move on

What does zhǐwàng mean? (“To count on someone”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 533

I Hope So

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I hope, long for and yearn for, say when hope runs out, and wish someone well.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 533: I can say what I hope, long for and yearn for, say when hope runs out, and wish someone well.*

533.1 xiàngwǎng — to yearn for

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as one would wish it, then the Mandarin for to count on someone.

You'll want to know: xiàngwǎng

xiàngwǎng — "to yearn for".

> *rúguǒ yǒu jīhuì wǒ jiù qù wǒ xiàngwǎng de dìfang* — If I get the chance, I'll go to the place I've always longed for.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàngwǎng is built from *xiàng* 'towards' and 往 'to go', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjangH* and *hjwangX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which gives the first as the same word as its usual spelling and glosses the second 'to go to'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàngwǎng*
- *Say it: xiàngwǎng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ yǒu jīhuì wǒ jiù qù wǒ xiàngwǎng de dìfang* — If I get the chance, I'll go to the place I've always longed for.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as one would wish it, then the Mandarin for to count on someone, then say *xiàngwǎng* again

Before you move on

What does xiàngwǎng mean? ("To yearn for".) Say it once more.

533.2 希望 (xīwàng) — to hope

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to count on someone, then the Mandarin for to yearn for.

You'll want to know: 希望

希望 — *xīwàng* — "to hope".

我希望明天不下雨 *wǒ xīwàng míngtiān bú xiàyǔ* — I hope it doesn't rain tomorrow.

The new character, in pieces: 希 — seven strokes in three pieces: a small cross of two strokes on top; a long bar with a long stroke falling to the left through it; and at the foot three strokes, a short vertical, a bar that turns down and hooks, and a long vertical through the middle. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

希望 (*xīwàng*) is built from 希 and 望 'to look out for', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xj+j* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's

transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'to stop', 'to scatter' and, after an older dictionary, 'rare', and also with the second: 'to hope'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīwàng*
- *Say it: xīwàng*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ xīwàng míngtiān bú xiàyǔ* — I hope it doesn't rain tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to count on someone, then the Mandarin for to yearn for, then say *xīwàng* again

Before you move on

What does 希望 mean? ("To hope".) Say it once more.

533.3 希 — a cross, a bar and a long stroke, then three at the foot

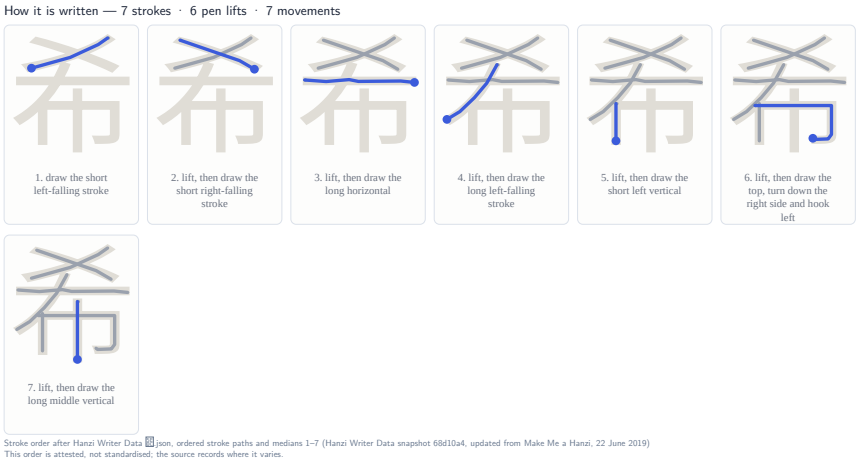
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *xīwàng* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  望 有

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *wàng*, *yǒu*

Script — a cross, a bar and a long stroke, then three at the foot



How 希 is written, stroke by stroke

希

Three pieces, top to bottom. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The top piece, two strokes: a short stroke falling to the left, then a short stroke falling to the right across it, a small cross.

The middle piece, two strokes: a long bar, then a long stroke falling to the left from above the bar down through it.

The bottom piece, three strokes: a short vertical on the left, a bar that turns down the right side and hooks to the left, then a long vertical down through the middle, past the foot.

2 + 2 + 3 = seven.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 希, all seven, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many strokes does 希 have? (**Seven**.) What is the last stroke? (**A long vertical through the middle of the foot**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 希, pinned stroke paths and medians.

533.4 kěwàng — to thirst for; to crave

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to yearn for, then the Mandarin for to hope that.

You'll want to know: kěwàng

kěwàng — "to thirst for; to crave".

tā hěn kěwàng dāng yīshēng — He longs to be a doctor.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

kěwàng is built from *kě* 'thirsty' and 望 'to look out for', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khat* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'hunger and thirst'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: kěwàng*
- *Say it: kěwàng*, once more
- *Say it: tā hěn kěwàng dāng yīshēng* — He longs to be a doctor.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to yearn for, then the Mandarin for to hope that, then say *kěwàng* again

Before you move on

What does kěwàng mean? ("To thirst for; to crave".) Say it once more.

533.5 juéwàng — to give up all hope; to despair

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to hope that, then the Mandarin for to thirst for.

You'll want to know: juéwàng

juéwàng — "to give up all hope; to despair".

jíshǐ shībài le yě búyào juéwàng — Even if you fail, don't give up hope.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

juéwàng is built from *jué* 'to cut off' and 望 'a hope', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjwet* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to break off'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: juéwàng*
- *Say it: juéwàng*, once more
- *Say it: jíshǐ shībài le yě búyào juéwàng* — Even if you fail, don't give up hope.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to hope that, then the Mandarin for to thirst for, then say *juéwàng* again

Before you move on

What does juéwàng mean? ("To give up all hope; to despair".) Say it once more.

533.6 心想事成 (xīnxiǎng shìchéng) — may your wishes all come true

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to thirst for, then the Mandarin for to give up all hope.

You'll want to know: 心想事成

心想事成 — *xīnxiǎng shìchéng* — "may your wishes all come true".

祝你们好运心想事成 *zhù nǐmen hǎoyùn xīnxiǎng shìchéng* — Good luck to you all, and may all your wishes come true.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

心想事成 (*xīnxiǎng shìchéng*) is built from 心 'the heart', 想 'to wish', 事 'a matter' and 成 'done', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *sim*, *sjangX*, *dzriH* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): what the heart thinks of, may it be done.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: xīnxiǎng shìchéng*
- *Say it: xīnxiǎng shìchéng*, once more
- *Say it: zhù nǐmen hǎoyùn xīnxiǎng shìchéng* — Good luck to you all, and may all your wishes come true.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to thirst for, then the Mandarin for to give up all hope, then say *xīnxiǎng shìchéng* again

Before you move on

What does 心想事成 mean? ("May your wishes all come true".) Say it once more.

Chapter 534

I'd Rather

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I'd rather, that I'll do what I can, suppose something, give my word and wish someone all the best.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 534: I can say I'd rather, that I'll do what I can, suppose something, give my word and wish someone all the best.*

534.1 nìngkě — would rather

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give up all hope, then the Mandarin for may your wishes all come true.

You'll want to know: nìngkě

nìngkě — "would rather".

> *wǒ nìngkě zǒulù yě bù xiǎng děng chē* — I'd rather walk than wait for the bus.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nìngkě is built from *nìng* and 可 'may', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *neng* and *khaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first 'calm' and, after an older dictionary, as a word of wishing. The falling tone of nìng is not the regular outcome of

neng, which gives níng.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: nìngkě*
- *Say it: nìngkě*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ nìngkě zǒulù yě bù xiǎng děng chē* — I'd rather walk than wait for the bus.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give up all hope, then the Mandarin for may your wishes all come true, then say *nìngkě* again

Before you move on

What does nìngkě mean? ("Would rather".) Say it once more.

534.2 jǐnliàng — as far as one can

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for may your wishes all come true, then the Mandarin for would rather.

You'll want to know: jǐnliàng

jǐnliàng — "as far as one can".

rúguǒ nǐ yǒu wèntí wǒ huì jǐnliàng bāng nǐ — If you have a problem, I'll do what I can to help.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

jǐnliàng is built from *jǐn* 'to the full' and 量 'an amount'. No dictionary we use records an older form of *jǐn* as this word writes it, so its history is not settled. 量 is inherited from Middle Chinese *ljangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jǐnliàng*
- *Say it: jǐnliàng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ yǒu wèntí wǒ huì jǐnliàng bāng nǐ* — If you have a problem, I'll do what I can to help.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for may your wishes all come true, then the Mandarin for would rather, then say *jǐnliàng* again

Before you move on

What does jǐnliàng mean? ("As far as one can".) Say it once more.

534.3 假如 (jiǎrú) — supposing that

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for would rather, then the Mandarin for as far as one can.

You'll want to know: 假如

假如 — *jiǎrú* — "supposing that".

假如明天下雨我们就不去了 *jiǎrú míngtiān xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù bú qù le* — Supposing it rains tomorrow, we won't go.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

假如 (*jiǎrú*) is built from 假 jiǎ and 如 'like', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kaeX* and *nyo* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to borrow', 'false' and 'for the time being': a borrowed case.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: jiǎrú*
- *Say it: jiǎrú*, once more
- *Say it: jiǎrú míngtiān xiàyǔ wǒmen jiù bú qù le* — Supposing it rains tomorrow, we won't go.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for would rather, then the Mandarin for as far as one can, then say *jiǎrú* again

Before you move on

What does 假如 mean? ("Supposing that".) Say it once more.

534.4 xǔnuò — to give one's word; to pledge

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as far as one can, then the Mandarin for supposing that.

You'll want to know: xǔnuò

xǔnuò — "to give one's word; to pledge".

rúguǒ nǐ xǔnuò le jiù yídìng yào zuò dào — If you've given your word, you must keep it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xǔnuò is built from *xǔ* 'to allow' and *nuò* 'to say yes', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *xjoX* and *nak* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to permit' and the second, after an older dictionary, 'to answer'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: xǔnuò*
- *Say it: xǔnuò*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ xǔnuò le jiù yídìng yào zuò dào* — If you've given your word, you must keep it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as far as one can, then the Mandarin for supposing that, then say *xǔnuò* again

Before you move on

What does xǔnuò mean? ("To give one's word; to pledge".) Say it once more.

534.5 万事如意 (wànshì rúyì) — may all go as you wish

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for supposing that, then the Mandarin for to give one's word.

You'll want to know: 万事如意

万事如意 — *wànshì rúyì* — "may all go as you wish".

希望你万事如意 *xīwàng nǐ wànshì rúyì* — I hope everything goes well for you.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

万事如意 (*wànshì rúyì*) is built from 万 'ten thousand', 事 'a matter', 如 'like' and 意 'what one means', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjonH*, *dzriH*, *nyo* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): every matter as you would have it.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: wànshì rúyì*
- *Say it: wànshì rúyì*, once more
- *Say it: xīwàng nǐ wànshì rúyì* — I hope everything goes well for you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for supposing that, then the Mandarin for to give one's word, then say *wànshì rúyì* again

Before you move on

What does 万事如意 mean? ("May all go as you wish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 535

If You're Willing

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I'm willing, talk about wishes, getting what I hoped for and doing something of my own free will, and say let's hope.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 535: I can say I'm willing, talk about wishes, getting what I hoped for and doing something of my own free will, and say let's hope.*

535.1 愿意 (yuànyì) — to be willing (to)

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to give one's word, then the Mandarin for may all go as you wish.

You'll want to know: 愿意

愿意 — *yuànyì* — "to be willing (to)".

> 要是你愿意我们明天就去 *yàoshi nǐ yuànyì wǒmen míngtiān jiù qù* — If you're willing, we'll go tomorrow.

The new character, in pieces: 愿 — fourteen strokes in four pieces: a bar and a long stroke falling to the left, like a cliff; under it 白, five strokes, and 小, three strokes; and 心 at the foot, four strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

愿意 (*yuànyì*) is built from 愿 and 意 'what one means', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwonH* and *'iH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to desire' and 'to think of'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuànyì*
- *Say it: yuànyì*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ yuànyì wǒmen míngtiān jiù qù* — If you're willing, we'll go tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to give one's word, then the Mandarin for may all go as you wish, then say *yuànyì* again

Before you move on

What does 愿意 mean? ("To be willing (to)".) Say it once more.

535.2 愿 — a cliff over 白 and 小, then 心

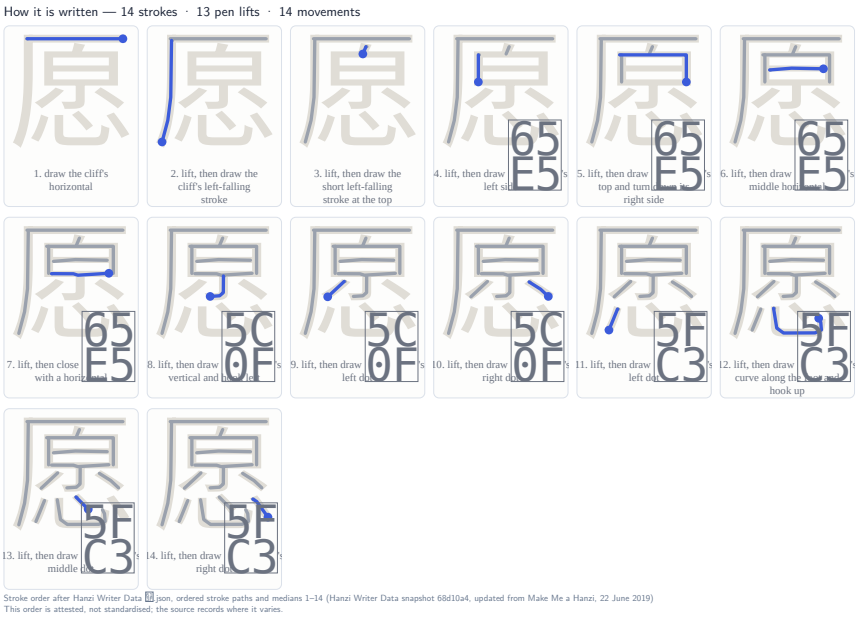
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yuànyì* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  白 心

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *bái*, *xīn*

Script — a cliff over 白 and 小, then 心



How 愿 *is written, stroke by stroke*

愿

Four pieces: the cliff, then what it shelters, then 心 at the foot. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The cliff, two strokes: a bar, then a long stroke falling to the left down from its left end.

Under the cliff, 白, five strokes, then 小, three strokes, as you wrote them: a short stroke falling to the left, a vertical, a bar that turns down, two short bars; then a vertical that hooks to the left, a short stroke on its left and a dot on its right.

心, four strokes, as you wrote it, across the foot: a dot, a long curve that hooks up, then two dots.

2 + 5 + 3 + 4 = fourteen.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 愿, all fourteen, with the model in front of you

- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 愿 have? (**Four: the cliff, 白, 小 and 心.**)
Which piece comes last? (**心, at the foot.**)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 愿, pinned stroke paths and medians.

535.3 愿望 (yuànwàng) — a wish one has; a desire

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for may all go as you wish, then the Mandarin for to be willing.

You'll want to know: 愿望

愿望 — *yuànwàng* — "a wish one has; a desire".

如果可以有一个愿望你想要什么 *rúguǒ kěyǐ yǒu yí ge yuànwàng nǐ xiǎng yào shénme* — If you could have one wish, what would you want?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

愿望 (*yuànwàng*) is built from 愿 'to desire' and 望 'a hope', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwonH* and *mjangH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription).

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuànwàng*
- *Say it: yuànwàng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ kěyǐ yǒu yí ge yuànwàng nǐ xiǎng yào shénme* — If you could have one wish, what would you want?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for may all go as you wish, then the Mandarin for to be willing, then say *yuànwàng* again

Before you move on

What does 愿望 mean? ("A wish one has; a desire".) Say it once more.

535.4 如愿 (rúyuàn) — to get what one wished for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to be willing, then the Mandarin for a wish one has.

You'll want to know: 如愿

如愿 — *rúyuàn* — "to get what one wished for".

zhǐyào nǐ nǔlì jiù néng rúyuàn — As long as you work hard, you'll get what you hoped for.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

如愿 (*rúyuàn*) is built from 如 'as, like' and 愿 'a wish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nyo* and *ngjwonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): as one wished.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: rúyuàn*
- *Say it: rúyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào nǐ nǔlì jiù néng rúyuàn* — As long as you work hard, you'll get what you hoped for.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to be willing, then the Mandarin for a wish one has, then say *rúyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does 如愿 mean? ("To get what one wished for".) Say it once more.

535.5 自愿 (zìyuàn) — of one's own free will; voluntary

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a wish one has, then the Mandarin for to get what one wished for.

You'll want to know: 自愿

自愿 — *zìyuàn* — "of one's own free will; voluntary".

我们自愿在这儿工作 *wǒmen zìyuàn zài zhèr gōngzuò* — We work here of our own free will.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

自愿 (*zìyuàn*) is built from 自 'self' and 愿 'to wish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzijH* and *ngjwonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'from' and 'by way of'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zìyuàn*
- *Say it: zìyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen zìyuàn zài zhèr gōngzuò* — We work here of our own free will.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a wish one has, then the Mandarin for to get what one wished for, then say *zìyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does 自愿 mean? ("Of one's own free will; voluntary".) Say it once more.

535.6 但愿 (dànyuàn) — let us hope that; if only

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get what one wished for, then the Mandarin for of one's own free will.

You'll want to know: 但愿

但愿 — *dànyuàn* — "let us hope that; if only".

但愿他明天能来 *dànyuàn tā míngtiān néng lái* — Let's hope he can come tomorrow.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

但愿 (*dànyuàn*) is built from 但 'only' and 愿 'to wish', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *danX* and *ngjwonH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first as a grammar word and 'merely': I only wish.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dànyuàn*
- *Say it: dànyuàn*, once more
- *Say it: dànyuàn tā míngtiān néng lái* — Let's hope he can come tomorrow.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get what one wished for, then the Mandarin for of one's own free will, then say *dànyuàn* again

Before you move on

What does 但愿 mean? ("Let us hope that; if only".) Say it once more.

Chapter 536

When Wishes Come True

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a wish comes true, a dream is fulfilled and life gets better, tell a dream, and say there's something to look forward to.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 536: I can say a wish comes true, a dream is fulfilled and life gets better, tell a dream, and say there's something to look forward to.*

536.1 成真 (chéngzhēn) — to become reality (of a wish)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for of one's own free will, then the Mandarin for let us hope that.

You'll want to know: 成真

成真 — *chéngzhēn* — "to become reality (of a wish)".

> 希望我的愿望能成真 *xīwàng wǒ de yuànwàng néng chéngzhēn* — I hope my wish comes true.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

成真 (*chéngzhēn*) is built from 成 'to become' and 真 'true', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzyeng* and *tsyin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as the true against

the false.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéngzhēn*
- *Say it: chéngzhēn*, once more
- *Say it: xīwàng wǒ de yuànwàng néng chéngzhēn* — I hope my wish comes true.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for of one's own free will, then the Mandarin for let us hope that, then say *chéngzhēn* again

Before you move on

What does **成真** mean? ("To become reality (of a wish)".) Say it once more.

536.2 yuánmèng — to fulfil a dream

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for let us hope that, then the Mandarin for to become reality.

You'll want to know: yuánmèng

yuánmèng — "to fulfil a dream".

rúguǒ míngnián néng qù Zhōngguó wǒ jiù yuánmèng le — If I can go to China next year, my dream will have come true.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

yuánmèng is built from *yuán* 'round, whole' and *mèng* 'a dream', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *hjwen* and *mjuwngH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second, after an older

dictionary, as waking within sleep: a dream made whole.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuánmèng*
- *Say it: yuánmèng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ míngnián néng qù Zhōngguó wǒ jiù yuánmèng le* — If I can go to China next year, my dream will have come true.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for let us hope that, then the Mandarin for to become reality, then say *yuánmèng* again

Before you move on

What does yuánmèng mean? ("To fulfil a dream".) Say it once more.

536.3 měihǎo — fine and happy (of a life or a future)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to become reality, then the Mandarin for to fulfil a dream.

You'll want to know: měihǎo

měihǎo — "fine and happy (of a life or a future)".

zhǐyào dàjiā nǔlì shēnghuó jiù huì gèng měihǎo — As long as everyone works hard, life will get better.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

Two third tones meet in this word: měi is said with a rising tone before hǎo, and the spelling keeps both marks.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

měihǎo is built from *měi* 'beautiful' and 好 'good', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mijX* and *xawX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'good-looking' and, after an older dictionary, 'sweet', and the second 'good, beautiful'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: měihǎo*
- *Say it: měihǎo*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào dàjiā nǔlì shēnghuó jiù huì gèng měihǎo* — As long as everyone works hard, life will get better.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to become reality, then the Mandarin for to fulfil a dream, then say *měihǎo* again

Before you move on

What does měihǎo mean? ("Fine and happy (of a life or a future)".) Say it once more.

536.4 mèngjiàn — to dream of; to see in a dream

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to fulfil a dream, then the Mandarin for fine and happy.

You'll want to know: mèngjiàn

mèngjiàn — "to dream of; to see in a dream".

wǒ zuótiān wǎnshang mèngjiàn wǒ zhòngjiǎng le — Last night I dreamt I had won a prize.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

mèngjiàn is built from *mèng* 'a dream' and 见 'to see', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjuwngH* and *kenH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second 'to look'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: mèngjiàn*
- *Say it: mèngjiàn*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ zuótiān wǎnshang mèngjiàn wǒ zhòngjiǎng le* — Last night I dreamt I had won a prize.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to fulfil a dream, then the Mandarin for fine and happy, then say *mèngjiàn* again

Before you move on

What does mèngjiàn mean? ("To dream of; to see in a dream".) Say it once more.

536.5 pàntou — something to look forward to

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for fine and happy, then the Mandarin for to see in a dream.

You'll want to know: pàntou

pàntou — "something to look forward to".

> *yǒu le gōngzuò shēnghuó jiù yǒu pàntou le* — With a job, life has something to look forward to.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

pàntou is built from *pàn* 'to long for' and 头, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pheanH* and *duw* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as beautiful eyes; the sense 'to long for' is not given there. The second, 'the head', is said light here, as at the end of other nouns.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: pàntou*
- *Say it: pàntou*, once more
- *Say it: yǒu le gōngzuò shēnghuó jiù yǒu pàntou le* — With a job, life has something to look forward to.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for fine and happy, then the Mandarin for to see in a dream, then say *pàntou* again

Before you move on

What does pàntou mean? ("Something to look forward to".) Say it once more.

536.6 Looking back: from Hoping for More to When Wishes Come True

Say the Mandarin for with good hopes of it and to be dying to.

Your turn

- *Say it:* with good hopes of it, to be dying to, to expect much of someone, as one would wish it, to count on someone
- *Say it:* to yearn for, to hope that, to thirst for, to give up all hope, may your wishes all come true

- *Say it:* would rather, as far as one can, supposing that, to give one's word, may all go as you wish
- *Say it:* to be willing, a wish one has, to get what one wished for, of one's own free will, let us hope that
- *Say it:* to become reality, to fulfil a dream, fine and happy, to see in a dream, something to look forward to
- *Read it:* 望 希 愿 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

With good hopes of it? (有望, *yǒuwàng.*) To be dying to? (*bābude.*) To expect much of someone? (期望, *qīwàng.*) As one would wish it? (如意, *rúyì.*) To count on someone? (*zhǐwàng.*) To yearn for? (*xiàngwǎng.*) To hope that? (希望, *xīwàng.*) To thirst for? (*kěwàng.*) To give up all hope? (*juéwàng.*) May your wishes all come true? (心想事成, *xīnxiǎng shìchéng.*) Would rather? (*nìngkě.*) As far as one can? (*jǐnliàng.*) Supposing that? (假如, *jiǎrú.*) To give one's word? (*xǔnuò.*) May all go as you wish? (万事如意, *wànshì rúyì.*) To be willing? (愿意, *yuànyì.*) A wish one has? (愿望, *yuànwàng.*) To get what one wished for? (如愿, *rúyuàn.*) Of one's own free will? (自愿, *zìyuàn.*) Let us hope that? (但愿, *dànyuàn.*) To become reality? (成真, *chéngzhēn.*) To fulfil a dream? (*yuánmèng.*) Fine and happy? (*měihǎo.*) To see in a dream? (*mèngjiàn.*) Something to look forward to? (*pàntou.*)

Chapter 537

As It Turns Out

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what started something, that it turns out to be so, what it leads to and causes, and whether it works.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 537: I can say what started something, that it turns out to be so, what it leads to and causes, and whether it works.*

537.1 起因 (qǐyīn) — what set it off; the starting cause

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to see in a dream, then the Mandarin for something to look forward to.

You'll want to know: 起因

起因 — *qǐyīn* — "what set it off; the starting cause".

> *rúguǒ zhīdào le qǐyīn jiù néng jiějué wèntí* — If we know what set it off, we can solve the problem.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

起因 (*qǐyīn*) is built from 起 'to rise, to start' and 因 'a cause', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *khiX* and *'jin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to rise' and 'to start' and the

second 'to rest on' and 'to follow from'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qǐyīn*
- *Say it: qǐyīn*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ zhīdào le qǐyīn jiù néng jiějué wèntí* — If we know what set it off, we can solve the problem.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to see in a dream, then the Mandarin for something to look forward to, then say *qǐyīn* again

Before you move on

What does 起因 mean? ("What set it off; the starting cause".) Say it once more.

537.2 原来 (yuánlái) — so (it turns out); as it turns out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for something to look forward to, then the Mandarin for what set it off.

You'll want to know: 原来

原来 — *yuánlái* — "so (it turns out); as it turns out".

原来你也在这儿 *yuánlái nǐ yě zài zhèr* — So you're here too!

The new character, in pieces: 原 — ten strokes: the cliff, a bar and a long stroke falling to the left, as at the top of 愿; under it 白, five strokes, and 小, three strokes: 愿 without its heart. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

原来 (*yuánlái*) is built from 原 and 来 'to come', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ngjwon* and *loj* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription). The dictionary glosses the first as wide flat land, a plain; the sense 'origin' is not given there, and how the pair came to mean 'as it turns out' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuánlái*
- *Say it: yuánlái*, once more
- *Say it: yuánlái nǐ yě zài zhèr* — So you're here too!
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for something to look forward to, then the Mandarin for what set it off, then say *yuánlái* again

Before you move on

What does 原来 mean? ("So (it turns out); as it turns out".) Say it once more.

537.3 原 — the cliff over 白 and 小

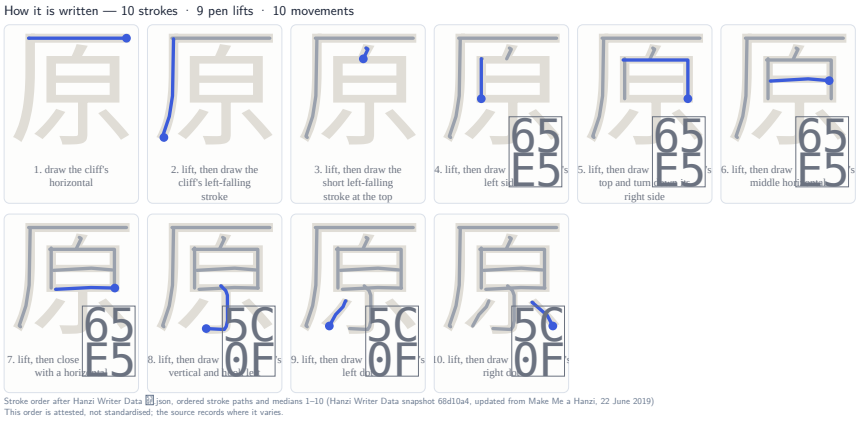
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *yuánlái* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  愿 白

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *yuàn*, *bái*

Script — the cliff over 白 and 小



How 原 is written, stroke by stroke

原

Three pieces: the cliff, then 白, then 小 under it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The cliff, two strokes: a bar, then a long stroke falling to the left down from its left end.

白, five strokes, under the cliff's arm: a short stroke falling to the left, a vertical, a bar that turns down, two short bars.

小, three strokes: a vertical that hooks to the left, a short stroke on its left, a dot on its right.

2 + 5 + 3 = ten, the first ten strokes of 愿.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 原, all ten, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

Which character is 原 with 心 under it? (愿.) How many strokes does 原 have? (**Ten**.)
Source: Hanzi Writer Data 原, pinned stroke paths and medians.

537.4 dǎozhì — to result in something bad

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what set it off, then the Mandarin for as it turns out.

You'll want to know: dǎozhì

dǎozhì — "to result in something bad".

> *rúguǒ bú zhùyì jiù huì dǎozhì shìgù* — If you're careless, it will lead to an accident.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

dǎozhì is built from *dǎo* 'to lead' and *zhì* 'to bring to', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dawH* and *trijH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to lead' and the second 'to arrive' and 'to send to'. The dipping tone of dǎo is not the regular outcome of *dawH*.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: dǎozhì*
- *Say it: dǎozhì*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ bú zhùyì jiù huì dǎozhì shìgù* — If you're careless, it will lead to an accident.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what set it off, then the Mandarin for as it turns out, then say *dǎozhì* again

Before you move on

What does dǎozhì mean? ("To result in something bad".) Say it once more.

537.5 zàochéng — to cause damage or trouble

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for as it turns out, then the Mandarin for to result in something bad.

You'll want to know: zàochéng

zàochéng — "to cause damage or trouble".

rúguǒ nǐ bù shuō jiù huì zàochéng wùhuì — If you don't say anything, it will cause a misunderstanding.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zàochéng is built from *zào* 'to make' and 成 'to complete', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzawX* and *dzyeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to make'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zàochéng*
- *Say it: zàochéng*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ bù shuō jiù huì zàochéng wùhuì* — If you don't say anything, it will cause a misunderstanding.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for as it turns out, then the Mandarin for to result in something bad, then say *zàochéng* again

Before you move on

What does zàochéng mean? ("To cause damage or trouble".) Say it once more.

537.6 xiàoguǒ — the effect it has (how well it works)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to result in something bad, then the Mandarin for to cause damage.

You'll want to know: xiàoguǒ

xiàoguǒ — "the effect it has (how well it works)".

yàoshi méiyǒu xiàoguǒ nǐ jiù huàn yí ge bànfǎ — If it doesn't work, try another way.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

xiàoguǒ is built from *xiào* and 果 'fruit', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *haewH* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to imitate' and 'proven effect': what the effort bears.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: xiàoguǒ*
- *Say it: xiàoguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi méiyǒu xiàoguǒ nǐ jiù huàn yí ge bànfǎ* — If it doesn't work, try another way.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to result in something bad, then the Mandarin for to cause damage, then say *xiàoguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does xiàoguǒ mean? ("The effect it has (how well it works)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 538

One Thing Leads to Another

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say so as not to, and thereby, talk about the thing itself and what it gives rise to, and say not at all.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 538: I can say so as not to, and thereby, talk about the thing itself and what it gives rise to, and say not at all.*

538.1 miǎnde — so as not to; lest

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to cause damage, then the Mandarin for how well it works.

You'll want to know: miǎnde

miǎnde — "so as not to; lest".

> *nǐ zuìhǎo dài yǔsǎn miǎnde línyǔ* — You'd better take an umbrella, so you don't get caught in the rain.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

miǎnde is built from *miǎn* 'to escape' and 得, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *mjenX* and *tok* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to stop' and 'to get free of'; the second is said light.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: miǎnde*
- *Say it: miǎnde*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ zuìhǎo dài yǔsǎn miǎnde línyǔ* — You'd better take an umbrella, so you don't get caught in the rain.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to cause damage, then the Mandarin for how well it works, then say *miǎnde* again

Before you move on

What does miǎnde mean? ("So as not to; lest".) Say it once more.

538.2 cóng'ér — and thereby; and in this way

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for how well it works, then the Mandarin for so as not to.

You'll want to know: cóng'ér

cóng'ér — "and thereby; and in this way".

wǒmen gǎi le shíjiān cóng'ér jiějué le zhège wèntí — We changed the time, and so solved the problem.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

cóng'ér is built from 从 'to follow' and *ér* 'and', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzjowng* and *nyi* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the second as a grammar word.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: cóng'ér*
- *Say it: cóng'ér*, once more
- *Say it: wǒmen gǎi le shíjiān cóng'ér jiějué le zhège wèntí* — We changed the time, and so solved the problem.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for how well it works, then the Mandarin for so as not to, then say *cóng'ér* again

Before you move on

What does cóng'ér mean? ("And thereby; and in this way".) Say it once more.

538.3 本身 (běnshēn) — itself (in itself)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for so as not to, then the Mandarin for and thereby.

You'll want to know: 本身

本身 — *běnshēn* — "itself (in itself)".

这个问题本身不大 *zhège wèntí běnshēn bú dà* — The problem itself isn't a big one.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

本身 (*běnshēn*) is built from 本 'the root' and 身 'the body', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *pwonX* and *syin* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which says, after an older dictionary, that the base of a tree is *pwonX*.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: běnshēn*
- *Say it: běnshēn*, once more
- *Say it: zhège wèntí běnshēn bú dà* — The problem itself isn't a big one.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for so as not to, then the Mandarin for and thereby, then say *běnshēn* again

Before you move on

What does 本身 mean? ("Itself (in itself)".) Say it once more.

538.4 chǎnshēng — to arise; to come about

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for and thereby, then the Mandarin for in itself.

You'll want to know: chǎnshēng

chǎnshēng — "to arise; to come about".

yàoshi bù shuō qīngchu jiù huì chǎnshēng wùhuì — If you don't make it clear, misunderstandings will arise.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chǎnshēng is built from *chǎn* 'to bear' and 生 'to be born', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *sreanX* and *srjaeng* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to give birth'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chǎnshēng*
- *Say it: chǎnshēng*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi bù shuō qīngchu jiù huì chǎnshēng wùhuì* — If you don't make it clear, misunderstandings will arise.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for and thereby, then the Mandarin for in itself, then say *chǎnshēng* again

Before you move on

What does chǎnshēng mean? ("To arise; to come about".) Say it once more.

538.5 gēnběn — not in the least; (not) at all

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for in itself, then the Mandarin for to arise from something.

You'll want to know: gēnběn

gēnběn — "not in the least; (not) at all".

> *jíshǐ nǐ shuō le tā yě gēnběn bù tīng* — Even if you tell him, he won't listen at all.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gēnběn is built from *gēn* 'a root' and 本 'the base of a tree', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kon* and *pwonX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'roots': down to the roots.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gēnběn*
- *Say it: gēnběn*, once more
- *Say it: jíshǐ nǐ shuō le tā yě gēnběn bù tīng* — Even if you tell him, he won't listen at all.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for in itself, then the Mandarin for to arise from something, then say *gēnběn* again

Before you move on

What does gēnběn mean? ("Not in the least; (not) at all".) Say it once more.

Chapter 539

Whose Fault?

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who is to blame, say something is strange, and talk about provoking someone, coming off worse and getting into trouble.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 539: I can say who is to blame, say something is strange, and talk about provoking someone, coming off worse and getting into trouble.*

539.1 rě — to stir up trouble; to provoke

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to arise from something, then the Mandarin for not in the least.

You'll want to know: rě

rě — "to stir up trouble; to provoke".

> *nǐ búyào rě tā bùrán tā huì shēngqì* — Don't provoke him, or he'll get angry.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

rě is inherited from Middle Chinese *nyaeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'a troubled mind'; the dictionary also lists *nyak*. The sense 'to provoke' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: rě*
- *Say it: rě*, once more
- *Say it: nǐ búyào rě tā bùrán tā huì shēngqì* — Don't provoke him, or he'll get angry.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to arise from something, then the Mandarin for not in the least, then say *rě* again

Before you move on

What does rě mean? ("To stir up trouble; to provoke".) Say it once more.

539.2 怪 (guài) — to put the blame on someone

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for not in the least, then the Mandarin for to stir up trouble.

You'll want to know: 怪

怪 — *guài* — "to put the blame on someone".

这不能怪你原因不在你 *zhè bù néng guài nǐ yuányīn bú zài nǐ* — You can't be blamed for this: the cause doesn't lie with you.

The new character, in pieces: 怪 — eight strokes in three pieces: the upright heart on the left, three strokes, as in 快; on the right 又, two strokes; and under it the earth piece, three strokes. The next lesson puts it in your hand.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

怪 (*guài*) is inherited from Middle Chinese *kweajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'strange'. The sense 'to blame' is not

given there; it is usually explained as finding fault, but how it came is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: guài*
- *Say it: guài*, once more
- *Say it: zhè bù néng guài nǐ yuányīn bú zài nǐ* — You can't be blamed for this: the cause doesn't lie with you.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for not in the least, then the Mandarin for to stir up trouble, then say *guài* again

Before you move on

What does 怪 mean? ("To put the blame on someone".) Say it once more.

539.3 怪 — the upright heart, then 又 over the earth piece

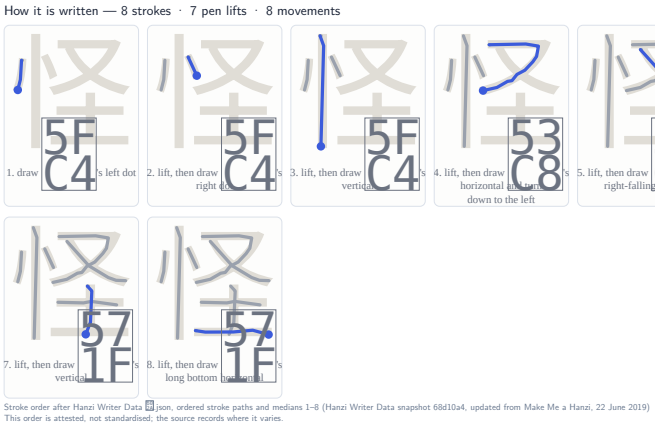
The word first, then the character inside it.

- *Recall:* say *guài* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

  快 地

Read it: each one aloud, with nothing said first — *kuài*, *dì*

Script — the upright heart, then 又 over the earth piece



How 怪 *is written, stroke by stroke*

怪

Three pieces: the upright heart on the left, then 又, then the earth piece under it. Count the pieces, not the strokes.

The upright heart, three strokes, as in 快: a short dot on the left, a short dot on the right, then a long vertical down between them.

又, two strokes, as you wrote it: a bar that turns into a long stroke falling to the left, then a long stroke falling to the right across it.

The earth piece, three strokes, as on the left of 地, but at the foot: a short bar, a vertical down through it, then a long bar along the foot.

3 + 2 + 3 = eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* 怪, all eight, with the model in front of you
- *Cover:* write it again from memory, and count the pieces, not the strokes

Before you move on

How many pieces does 怪 have? (**Three: the upright heart, 又 and the earth piece.**) Which piece is written last? (**The earth piece, at the foot.**)

Source: Hanzi Writer Data 怪, pinned stroke paths and medians.

539.4 怪事 (guàishì) — a strange business; an odd thing

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to stir up trouble, then the Mandarin for to put the blame on.

You'll want to know: 怪事

怪事 — *guàishì* — "a strange business; an odd thing".

这真是怪事 *zhè zhēn shì guàishì* — That really is a strange business.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

怪事 (*guàishì*) is built from 怪 'strange' and 事 'a matter', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kweajH* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'strange'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: guàishì*
- *Say it: guàishì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè zhēn shì guàishì* — That really is a strange business.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to stir up trouble, then the Mandarin for to put the blame on, then say *guàishì* again

Before you move on

What does 怪事 mean? ("A strange business; an odd thing".) Say it once more.

539.5 chīkuī — to come off worse; to lose out

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to put the blame on, then the Mandarin for a strange business.

You'll want to know: chīkuī

chīkuī — "to come off worse; to lose out".

rúguǒ nǐ bù tīng wǒ de jiù huì chīkuī — If you don't listen to me, you'll come off worse.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chīkuī is built from 吃 'to eat' and *kuī* 'a loss'. For the first the dictionary has *khek*, glossed 'to eat', under another spelling; the second is inherited from Middle Chinese *khjwe* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'to be lacking': to swallow a loss.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chīkuī*
- *Say it: chīkuī*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ nǐ bù tīng wǒ de jiù huì chīkuī* — If you don't listen to me, you'll come off worse.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to put the blame on, then the Mandarin for a strange business, then say *chīkuī* again

Before you move on

What does chīkuī mean? ("To come off worse; to lose out".) Say it once more.

539.6 chuǎnghuò — to get into trouble; to cause a mess

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for a strange business, then the Mandarin for to come off worse.

You'll want to know: chuǎnghuò

chuǎnghuò — "to get into trouble; to cause a mess".

yàoshi nǐ zài chuǎnghuò wǒ jiù gàosu nǐ māma — If you get into trouble again, I'll tell your mum.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

chuǎnghuò is built from *chuǎng* 'to rush' and *huò* 'disaster'. The second is inherited from Middle Chinese *hwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), glossed 'harm'. The dictionary lists the first as *trhimH*, a horse dashing out of a gate, but chuǎng is not the regular outcome of that form, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuǎnghuò*
- *Say it: chuǎnghuò*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ zài chuǎnghuò wǒ jiù gàosu nǐ māma* — If you get into trouble again, I'll tell your mum.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for a strange business, then the Mandarin for to come off worse, then say *chuǎnghuò* again

Before you move on

What does chuǎnghuò mean? ("To get into trouble; to cause a mess".) Say it once more.

Chapter 540

So That's Why

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone is odd, that something drags others in, that something is bound to happen, tell the whole story and ask what is going on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 540: I can say someone is odd, that something drags others in, that something is bound to happen, tell the whole story and ask what is going on.*

540.1 古怪 (gǔguài) — eccentric; peculiar (of a person)

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to come off worse, then the Mandarin for to get into trouble.

You'll want to know: 古怪

古怪 — *gǔguài* — "eccentric; peculiar (of a person)".

> 原来他是一个古怪的人 *yuánlái tā shì yí ge gǔguài de rén* — So he's an odd sort of man.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

古怪 (*gǔguài*) is built from 古 'old' and 怪 'strange', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kuX* and *kweajH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'of old' and the second 'strange'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǔguài*
- *Say it: gǔguài*, once more
- *Say it: yuánlái tā shì yí ge gǔguài de rén* — So he's an odd sort of man.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to come off worse, then the Mandarin for to get into trouble, then say *gǔguài* again

Before you move on

What does 古怪 mean? ("Eccentric; peculiar (of a person)".) Say it once more.

540.2 liánlei — to drag someone into trouble

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to get into trouble, then the Mandarin for eccentric.

You'll want to know: liánlei

liánlei — "to drag someone into trouble".

yàoshi wǒ chūshì le jiù huì liánlei dàjiā — If anything happens to me, everyone will be dragged into it.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

liánlei is built from *lián* 'to join' and *lei*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ljen* and *ljweH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to join, to continue' and the second as being caught up in another's offence. The second is said light here.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: liánlei*
- *Say it: liánlei*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi wǒ chūshì le jiù huì liánlei dàjiā* — If anything happens to me, everyone will be dragged into it.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to get into trouble, then the Mandarin for eccentric, then say *liánlei* again

Before you move on

What does liánlei mean? ("To drag someone into trouble".) Say it once more.

540.3 nánmiǎn — bound to happen; hard to avoid

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for eccentric, then the Mandarin for to drag someone into trouble.

You'll want to know: nánmiǎn

nánmiǎn — "bound to happen; hard to avoid".

rúguǒ shì dì yī cì zuò nánmiǎn huì chūcuò — If it's your first time, mistakes are bound to happen.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

nánmiǎn is built from 难 'hard' and *miǎn* 'to escape', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *nan* and *mjenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'difficult' and the second 'to stop' and 'to get free of': hard to get free of.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: nánmiǎn*
- *Say it: nánmiǎn*, once more
- *Say it: rúguǒ shì dì yī cì zuò nánmiǎn huì chūcuò* — If it's your first time, mistakes are bound to happen.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for eccentric, then the Mandarin for to drag someone into trouble, then say *nánmiǎn* again

Before you move on

What does nánmiǎn mean? ("Bound to happen; hard to avoid".) Say it once more.

540.4 前因后果 (qiányīn hòuguǒ) — the whole chain of causes and effects

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to drag someone into trouble, then the Mandarin for bound to happen.

You'll want to know: 前因后果

前因后果 — *qiányīn hòuguǒ* — "the whole chain of causes and effects".

yàoshi nǐ zhīdào qiányīn hòuguǒ jiù bú huì guài tā le — If you knew the whole story, you wouldn't blame him.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

前因后果 (*qiányīn hòuguǒ*) is built from 前 'before', 因 'a cause', 后 'after' and 果 'fruit', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *dzen*, *'jin*, *huwX* and *kwaX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription): the cause that came before and the fruit that came after.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: qiányīn hòuguǒ*
- *Say it: qiányīn hòuguǒ*, once more
- *Say it: yàoshi nǐ zhīdào qiányīn hòuguǒ jiù bú huì guài tā le* — If you knew the whole story, you wouldn't blame him.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to drag someone into trouble, then the Mandarin for bound to happen, then say *qiányīn hòuguǒ* again

Before you move on

What does 前因后果 mean? ("The whole chain of causes and effects".) Say it once more.

540.5 怎么回事 (zěnme huí shì) — what is going on here; what's the matter

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for bound to happen, then the Mandarin for the whole chain of causes.

You'll want to know: 怎么回事

怎么回事 — *zěnme huí shì* — "what is going on here; what's the matter".

这是怎么回事 *zhè shì zěnme huí shì* — What's going on here?

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

怎么回事 (*zěnme huí shì*) is built from 怎么 'how', 回 'a time' and 事 'a matter'. 回 and 事 are inherited from Middle Chinese, *hwoj* and *dzriH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); no dictionary we use records an older form of 怎, so its history is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zěnme huí shì*
- *Say it: zěnme huí shì*, once more
- *Say it: zhè shì zěnme huí shì* — What's going on here?
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for bound to happen, then the Mandarin for the whole chain of causes, then say *zěnme huí shì* again

Before you move on

What does 怎么回事 mean? ("What is going on here; what's the matter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 541

If It Weren't for You

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say if it weren't for, thanks to, things will improve, what the main reason is, and either this or that.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 541: I can say if it weren't for, thanks to, things will improve, what the main reason is, and either this or that.*

541.1 要不是 (yàobúshì) — if it were not for

> Before the new one: say the Mandarin for the whole chain of causes, then the Mandarin for what is going on here.

You'll want to know: 要不是

要不是 — *yàobúshì* — "if it were not for".

> 要不是你我们就找不到这儿了 *yàobúshì nǐ wǒmen jiù zhǎo bu dào zhèr le* — If it weren't for you, we'd never have found this place.

Tone: 不 is said bú before the falling tone of shì, and the spelling shows it.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

要不是 (*yàobúshì*) is built from 要 'if', 不 'not' and 是 'to be', all inherited from Middle Chinese, *'jiewH*, *pjut* and *dzyeX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the dictionary glosses the first 'to bind by agreement', and its use for 'if' is not given there.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàobúshì*
- *Say it: yàobúshì*, once more
- *Say it: yàobúshì nǐ wǒmen jiù zhǎo bu dào zhèr le* — If it weren't for you, we'd never have found this place.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for the whole chain of causes, then the Mandarin for what is going on here, then say *yàobúshì* again

Before you move on

What does 要不是 mean? ("If it were not for".) Say it once more.

541.2 duōkuī — it is thanks to; luckily for

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for what is going on here, then the Mandarin for if it were not for.

You'll want to know: duōkuī

duōkuī — "it is thanks to; luckily for".

duōkuī nǐ bāng wǒ bùrán wǒ jiù zuò bu wán — Thanks to your help I finished; otherwise I'd never have managed.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

duōkuī is built from 多 'much' and *kuī*, both inherited from Middle Chinese, *ta* and *khjwe* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'many' and the second 'to be lacking'. How the pair came to mean 'thanks to' is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: duōkuī*
- *Say it: duōkuī*, once more
- *Say it: duōkuī nǐ bāng wǒ bùrán wǒ jiù zuò bu wán* — Thanks to your help I finished; otherwise I'd never have managed.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for what is going on here, then the Mandarin for if it were not for, then say *duōkuī* again

Before you move on

What does duōkuī mean? ("It is thanks to; luckily for".) Say it once more.

541.3 gǎishàn — to make conditions better

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for if it were not for, then the Mandarin for it is thanks to.

You'll want to know: gǎishàn

gǎishàn — "to make conditions better".

zhǐyào dàjiā yìqǐ nǔlì huánjìng jiù huì gǎishàn — As long as we all work together, the environment will get better.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

gǎishàn is built from 改 'to change' and *shàn* 'good', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *kojX* and *dzyenX* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to alter' and the second 'good'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: gǎishàn*
- *Say it: gǎishàn*, once more
- *Say it: zhǐyào dàjiā yìqǐ nǔlì huánjìng jiù huì gǎishàn* — As long as we all work together, the environment will get better.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for if it were not for, then the Mandarin for it is thanks to, then say *gǎishàn* again

Before you move on

What does gǎishàn mean? ("To make conditions better".) Say it once more.

541.4 zhǔyào — main; chief

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for it is thanks to, then the Mandarin for to make conditions better.

You'll want to know: zhǔyào

zhǔyào — "main; chief".

wǒ bú qù de zhǔyào yuányīn shì tiānqì bù hǎo — The main reason I'm not going is the bad weather.

Its characters come later; for now it is a word for the ear.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

zhǔyào is built from *zhǔ* 'to be in charge' and 要 'important', both inherited from Middle Chinese, *tsyuX* and *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription), which glosses the first 'to manage, to lead' and the second 'to bind by agreement'.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhǔyào*
- *Say it: zhǔyào*, once more
- *Say it: wǒ bú qù de zhǔyào yuányīn shì tiānqì bù hǎo* — The main reason I'm not going is the bad weather.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for it is thanks to, then the Mandarin for to make conditions better, then say *zhǔyào* again

Before you move on

What does zhǔyào mean? ("Main; chief".) Say it once more.

541.5 要么 (yàome) — either one or the other; either ... or

Before the new one: say the Mandarin for to make conditions better, then the Mandarin for the main one.

You'll want to know: 要么

要么 — *yàome* — "either one or the other; either … or".

要么你来要么我去 *yàome nǐ lái yàome wǒ qù* — Either you come here or I go there.

The word, taken apart — what its characters are made of

要么 (*yàome*) is built from 要 and the light ending 么, as in 怎么. The first is inherited from Middle Chinese *'jiewH* (Guangyun, in Baxter's transcription); the second is said light, and its history in this use is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for saying what would happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: yàome*
- *Say it: yàome*, once more
- *Say it: yàome nǐ lái yàome wǒ qù* — Either you come here or I go there.
- *Recall:* say the Mandarin for to make conditions better, then the Mandarin for the main one, then say *yàome* again

Before you move on

What does 要么 mean? ("Either one or the other; either … or".) Say it once more.

541.6 Looking back: from As It Turns Out to If It Weren't for You

Say the Mandarin for what set it off and as it turns out.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what set it off, as it turns out, to result in something bad, to cause damage, how well it works
- *Say it:* so as not to, and thereby, in itself, to arise from something, not in the least

- *Say it:* to stir up trouble, to put the blame on, a strange business, to come off worse, to get into trouble
- *Say it:* eccentric, to drag someone into trouble, bound to happen, the whole chain of causes, what is going on here
- *Say it:* if it were not for, it is thanks to, to make conditions better, the main one, either one or the other
- *Read it:* 原 怪 — each one aloud, then a word that holds it

Before you move on

What set it off? (起因, *qǐyīn.*) As it turns out? (原来, *yuánlái.*) To result in something bad? (*dǎozhì.*) To cause damage? (*zàochéng.*) How well it works? (*xiàoguǒ.*) So as not to? (*miǎnde.*) And thereby? (*cóng'ér.*) In itself? (本身, *běnshēn.*) To arise from something? (*chǎnshēng.*) Not in the least? (*gēnběn.*) To stir up trouble? (*rě.*) To put the blame on? (怪, *guài.*) A strange business? (怪事, *guàishì.*) To come off worse? (*chīkuī.*) To get into trouble? (*chuǎnghuò.*) Eccentric? (古怪, *gǔguài.*) To drag someone into trouble? (*liánlei.*) Bound to happen? (*nánmiǎn.*) The whole chain of causes? (前因后果, *qiányīn hòuguǒ.*) What is going on here? (怎么回事, *zěnme huí shì.*) If it were not for? (要不是, *yàobúshì.*) It is thanks to? (*duōkuī.*) To make conditions better? (*gǎishàn.*) The main one? (*zhǔyào.*) Either one or the other? (要么, *yàome.*)

541.7 If It Weren't for You — once more

Say the Mandarin for if it were not for and it is thanks to.

Your turn

- *Say it:* if it were not for, it is thanks to, to make conditions better, the main one, either one or the other

Before you move on

If it were not for? (要不是, *yàobúshì.*) It is thanks to? (*duōkuī.*) To make conditions better? (*gǎishàn.*) The main one? (*zhǔyào.*) Either one or the other? (要么, *yàome.*)

Pronunciation & Character Guide

Reference material, never a gate. Every lesson teaches the sounds its own word needs, inline, and links here for anyone who wants the fuller picture. Nobody has to read this page before Lesson 1, and most readers never will.

The ids in each heading are the values a lesson's `sounds:` frontmatter list points at.

Why this page is different from every other track's

In an alphabetic or abugida track, "the sounds you'll need" is a list of *segments*: this letter is silent, that vowel is long, this consonant is retroflex. Each fact is attached to a letter, and the letter is on the page.

Mandarin adds a second, orthogonally different kind of fact. **Tone** rides on a whole syllable, is not written in the characters at all, and is *phonemic* — it distinguishes words the way a consonant does. A segmental note cannot express it. So this page has two halves: tones first, because they are the part an English speaker has no instinct for, then the segments.

The machine-readable form of the first half lives in the Chinese script reference under `tones` and `toneSandhi`.

Tones

Mandarin has four tones plus a neutral one. Pinyin writes the tone as a mark over the vowel; the characters do not record it anywhere.

The classic demonstration uses one syllable, *ma*:

- `tone-1` — first, high level (contour 55). Held high and flat, one steady note. *mā* — mother.
- `tone-2` — second, rising (35). Climbs from mid to high, like the pitch on a surprised English "huh?". *má* — hemp.

- `tone-3` — third, dipping (214). Sinks low and creaky; said alone it rises again a little at the end, but in running speech it usually just stays low. *mǎ* — horse.
- `tone-4` — fourth, falling (51). Drops sharply from high to low, like a clipped "No!". *mà* — to scold.
- `tone-neutral` — unstressed. Short and light, with no mark written at all, pitched by whatever came before it. *ma* — a question particle.

tone-lexical — tone is part of the word

The single fact that matters most, taught in the first lesson: changing the pitch of a Mandarin syllable changes **which word it is**, not how you feel about it. *mā*, *má*, *mǎ* and *mà* are four separate words. English uses pitch for mood and emphasis only, so this is a genuinely new job for an English speaker's voice.

tone-sandhi-third — two third tones in a row

When a third tone is followed by another third tone, the first is spoken as a rising second tone.

Written **nǐ hǎo**, said **ní hǎo**. Neither the pinyin nor the characters record the change; dictionaries print the citation tone each word carries alone. This is why a reader who trusts only the page mispronounces the commonest greeting in the language.

tone-sandhi-bu — 不 before a fourth tone

不 *bù* is said *bú* when the next syllable has a fourth tone: *bù shì* → *bú shì*. Taught in full on 不是, the first collocation in the track that forces it.

Segments

Pinyin is a romanization, not English spelling. A few letters do work you would not guess.

- `pinyin-n` — as in English *no*.
- `pinyin-i` — after most consonants, the *ee* of "see". (After *z-, c-, s-, zh-, ch-, sh-, r-* it is a different, buzzier vowel; no Chapter 1 word uses those.)

- `pinyin-h` — rougher than English *h*, scraped at the back of the mouth, closer to the *ch* of Scottish *loch* softened.
- `pinyin-ao` — one gliding vowel, the *ow* of "how". Not two syllables.

The characters themselves

Stroke shapes, components, and stroke order for every character this track has introduced live in Chinese script reference. Unlike the Indic scripts in this curriculum, where stroke order is conventional, Chinese stroke order is a **taught, standardised system** — top before bottom, left before right, horizontal before vertical, outside before inside, and close a box last. That file marks its stroke orders `authoritative` for exactly that reason.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

ài
to love
Introduced in Chapter 55.

ǎi
short in height; low
Introduced in Chapter 61.

àihào
hobby
Introduced in Chapter 250.

àihù
to cherish and protect; to treat with care
Introduced in Chapter 376.

爱情 *àiqíng*
romantic love; love between a couple
Introduced in Chapter 461.

爱心 *àixīn*
compassion; love and care for others
Introduced in Chapter 461.

àn
to press; to push down
Introduced in Chapter 171.

安定 *āndìng*
settled; stable
Introduced in Chapter 400.

安检 *ānjiǎn*
security check
Introduced in Chapter 415.

ānjìng
quiet
Introduced in Chapter 129.

ānpái
to arrange
Introduced in Chapter 207.

ānquán
safe; safety
Introduced in Chapter 209.

ānquándài
seat belt
Introduced in Chapter 414.

安全感 *ānquángǎn*
a sense of security
Introduced in Chapter 381.

ānwèi
to comfort; to console
Introduced in Chapter 314.

安心 *ānxīn*
with a mind at rest; settled
Introduced in Chapter 379.

ānzhuāng
to install; to put in
Introduced in Chapter 208.

áoyè
to stay up late; to stay up all night
Introduced in Chapter 169.

āyí
auntie; mother's sister
Introduced in Chapter 272.

八 *bā*
eight — first tone, and the luckiest number in the language
Introduced in Chapter 20.

bàba
dad; father
Introduced in Chapter 32.

bābude
to be dying to; to be eager for (colloquial)
Introduced in Chapter 532.

八成 *bāchéng*
most likely; eighty per cent
Introduced in Chapter 385.

白 *bái*
white; pale
Introduced in Chapter 60.

bàibai
bye-bye
Introduced in Chapter 76.

白菜 *báicài*
Chinese cabbage
Introduced in Chapter 101.

bàifǎng
to pay a visit to
Introduced in Chapter 338.

báifèi
to be wasted (of effort)
Introduced in Chapter 394.

bàinián
to pay a New Year call
Introduced in Chapter 333.

bǎitān
to set up a street stall
Introduced in Chapter 448.

白天 *báitiān*
daytime
Introduced in Chapter 146.

bàituō
to ask a favour of someone
Introduced in Chapter 457.

bàn
half
Introduced in Chapter 48.

bān
to move house; to move (something heavy)
Introduced in Chapter 107.

半岛 *bàndǎo*
peninsula
Introduced in Chapter 444.

bànfǎ
a way to deal with it
Introduced in Chapter 214.

bāng
to help
Introduced in Chapter 64.

bāngmáng
to help out; to do a favour
Introduced in Chapter 64.

bàngōngshì
office
Introduced in Chapter 206.

bàngwǎn
dusk; towards evening
Introduced in Chapter 169.

半价 *bànjià*
half price
Introduced in Chapter 524.

bànlǐ
to deal with the paperwork; to go through a procedure
Introduced in Chapter 418.

半路 *bànlù*
halfway; on the way
Introduced in Chapter 424.

bānmǎxiàn
zebra crossing; pedestrian crossing
Introduced in Chapter 194.

半天 *bàntiān*
a long while; half a day
Introduced in Chapter 143.

bànyè
the middle of the night
Introduced in Chapter 146.

báo
thin (of cloth or paper)
Introduced in Chapter 199.

bāo
bag
Introduced in Chapter 58.

bǎo
full after eating; full up
Introduced in Chapter 177.

报 *bào*
newspaper; the daily paper
Introduced in Chapter 293.

保安 *bǎo'ān*
security guard
Introduced in Chapter 382.

bǎobao
baby; darling (said to a small child)
Introduced in Chapter 266.

bǎochí
to keep up; to keep as it is
Introduced in Chapter 209.

bǎocún
to keep; to save
Introduced in Chapter 344.

bàodào
to report on; a news report
Introduced in Chapter 290.

报到 *bàodào*
to report in on arrival; to sign in
Introduced in Chapter 304.

bāoguǒ
parcel; package
Introduced in Chapter 118.

保护 *bǎohù*
to protect; to keep from harm
Introduced in Chapter 443.

保护区 *bǎohùqū*
nature reserve; protected area
Introduced in Chapter 443.

bǎojiàn
health care; looking after one's health
Introduced in Chapter 483.

bàojǐng
to call the police
Introduced in Chapter 216.

报考 *bàokǎo*
to enter for an exam; to apply to a school by exam
Introduced in Chapter 494.

bàomíng
to sign up; to enter (one's name)
Introduced in Chapter 268.

bàoqiàn
sorry; regretful
Introduced in Chapter 264.

bǎowù
treasure
Introduced in Chapter 331.

bǎoxiǎn
insurance
Introduced in Chapter 297.

bàoyuàn
to complain; to grumble
Introduced in Chapter 378.

bāozā
to bandage; to dress a wound
Introduced in Chapter 478.

bàozhà
to explode; to blow up
Introduced in Chapter 300.

bǎozhèng
to promise; to guarantee
Introduced in Chapter 382.

bǎozhòng
to look after yourself; to take care of oneself
Introduced in Chapter 245.

bāozhuāng
to wrap goods for sale
Introduced in Chapter 527.

bāozi
steamed bun
Introduced in Chapter 70.

báyá
to have a tooth pulled
Introduced in Chapter 473.

bēi
a cup of; a glass of (a measure word)
Introduced in Chapter 88.

bēibāo
backpack; rucksack
Introduced in Chapter 453.

běibian
the north; on the north side
Introduced in Chapter 117.

北部 *běibù*
northern part
Introduced in Chapter 438.

北方 *běifāng*
the north of the country; northern China
Introduced in Chapter 436.

bēiguān
pessimistic
Introduced in Chapter 465.

Běijīng
Beijing
Introduced in Chapter 36.

bèiké
seashell
Introduced in Chapter 445.

北上 *běishàng*
to go north; to head up north
Introduced in Chapter 422.

bèishū
to learn a text by heart; to recite from memory
Introduced in Chapter 496.

bèiyòng
spare (kept for when needed)
Introduced in Chapter 389.

bèizi
quilt; duvet
Introduced in Chapter 181.

bēizi
cup; glass
Introduced in Chapter 58.

bèn
slow-witted; clumsy
Introduced in Chapter 470.

běn
(a measure word for books)
Introduced in Chapter 88.

本地 *běndì*
local
Introduced in Chapter 211.

本来 *běnlái*
originally; at first
Introduced in Chapter 269.

本身 *běnshēn*
itself (in itself)
Introduced in Chapter 538.

本事 *běnshi*
skill; what someone is capable of
Introduced in Chapter 260.

本意 *běnyì*
what one really meant; original intention
Introduced in Chapter 352.

本子 *běnzi*
notebook
Introduced in Chapter 104.

bǐ
pen
Introduced in Chapter 104.

比 *bǐ*
than; compared with
Introduced in Chapter 153.

变成 *biànchéng*
to turn into
Introduced in Chapter 386.

biànhuà
to change over time; a change
Introduced in Chapter 243.

变老 *biànlǎo*
to get old
Introduced in Chapter 401.

变脸 *biànliǎn*
to turn hostile suddenly; to change one's attitude abruptly
Introduced in Chapter 472.

biānpào
firecrackers
Introduced in Chapter 335.

变天 *biàntiān*
to turn bad (of the weather)
Introduced in Chapter 386.

变心 *biànxīn*
to fall out of love; to stop being faithful
Introduced in Chapter 462.

biǎogé
a form to fill in
Introduced in Chapter 189.

biāoqiān
label; luggage tag
Introduced in Chapter 453.

biǎoqíng
facial expression; the look on one's face
Introduced in Chapter 472.

biǎoshì
to make your view known; to express
Introduced in Chapter 352.

biǎoyáng
to praise (in front of others)
Introduced in Chapter 357.

biāozhǔn
standard to measure by
Introduced in Chapter 364.

bié
don't
Introduced in Chapter 154.

biéde
something else; other
Introduced in Chapter 92.

biérén
other people
Introduced in Chapter 138.

bǐfēn
the score of a game
Introduced in Chapter 500.

bǐjì
notes (taken in class)
Introduced in Chapter 497.

bìjìng
after all; all things considered
Introduced in Chapter 370.

bìmiǎn
to avoid
Introduced in Chapter 366.

bìng
to fall ill; illness
Introduced in Chapter 50.

bīng
ice
Introduced in Chapter 221.

bìngdú
virus
Introduced in Chapter 481.

病房 *bìngfáng*
hospital ward
Introduced in Chapter 241.

bǐnggān
biscuit; cracker
Introduced in Chapter 102.

病假 *bìngjià*
sick leave
Introduced in Chapter 263.

病情 *bìngqíng*
a patient's condition; how an illness is going
Introduced in Chapter 481.

病人 *bìngrén*
patient; sick person
Introduced in Chapter 130.

bīnguǎn
hotel
Introduced in Chapter 200.

bīngxiāng
fridge; refrigerator
Introduced in Chapter 87.

病因 *bìngyīn*
cause of an illness
Introduced in Chapter 481.

比如 *bǐrú*
for instance; such as
Introduced in Chapter 281.

bǐsài
match; competition
Introduced in Chapter 135.

bìshǔ
to escape the summer heat
Introduced in Chapter 515.

必须 *bìxū*
must; it is required that
Introduced in Chapter 362.

必要 *bìyào*
necessary
Introduced in Chapter 360.

bìyè
to graduate; to finish school
Introduced in Chapter 254.

bǐyǒu
pen pal
Introduced in Chapter 318.

bízi
nose
Introduced in Chapter 230.

bōdǎ
to dial a number
Introduced in Chapter 320.

bówùguǎn
museum
Introduced in Chapter 190.

bózi
neck
Introduced in Chapter 476.

不 *bù*
not — the character that turns a word around
Introduced in Chapter 4.

bù hǎoyìsi
excuse me; sorry to trouble you
Introduced in Chapter 65.

不客气 *bú kèqi*
you're welcome; don't mention it
Introduced in Chapter 77.

不是 *bú shì*
is not — and a pitch that moves to get out of the way
Introduced in Chapter 5.

不谢 *bú xiè*
you're welcome — real and understood everywhere, though not the commonest reply, which needs characters this book cannot yet print
Introduced in Chapter 10.

不要 *bú yào*
don't; do not want
Introduced in Chapter 91.

不安 *bù'ān*
uneasy; worried
Introduced in Chapter 379.

不必 *búbì*
need not; there's no need to
Introduced in Chapter 360.

不变 *búbiàn*
unchanged; staying the same
Introduced in Chapter 394.

búcuò
not bad; pretty good
Introduced in Chapter 152.

不得不 *bùdébù*
to be obliged to; cannot help but
Introduced in Chapter 528.

bùfen
part; section (of a whole)
Introduced in Chapter 438.

bùguǎn
no matter (whether or how)
Introduced in Chapter 396.

不见得 *bújiànde*
not necessarily
Introduced in Chapter 353.

bǔpiào
to buy a ticket on board
Introduced in Chapter 404.

不然 *bùrán*
otherwise; or else
Introduced in Chapter 289.

不如 *bùrú*
to do better to; might as well; to be not as good as
Introduced in Chapter 365.

不同 *bùtóng*
different
Introduced in Chapter 256.

bǔxí
to take extra lessons
Introduced in Chapter 493.

bùxíng
to get there on foot
Introduced in Chapter 447.

búxìng
misfortune; unfortunate
Introduced in Chapter 531.

bùxíngjiē
pedestrian street; a street closed to cars
Introduced in Chapter 447.

bǔyá
to have a tooth filled
Introduced in Chapter 473.

bǔyú
to catch fish (for a living)
Introduced in Chapter 443.

bùzhì
to lay out a room; to decorate a room
Introduced in Chapter 521.

不准 *bùzhǔn*
to not allow
Introduced in Chapter 364.

cā
to wipe
Introduced in Chapter 133.

cài
dish of food; vegetable
Introduced in Chapter 38.

cāi
to guess
Introduced in Chapter 335.

才 *cái*
only then; not until
Introduced in Chapter 313.

càidān
menu
Introduced in Chapter 92.

cǎifǎng
to interview someone for the news
Introduced in Chapter 291.

cǎihóng
rainbow
Introduced in Chapter 238.

cǎipiào
lottery ticket
Introduced in Chapter 530.

cáng
to hide
Introduced in Chapter 331.

cānguān
to look round a place; to visit (a sight)
Introduced in Chapter 184.

cānjiā
to take part in; to join
Introduced in Chapter 84.

cānjīnzhǐ
paper napkin
Introduced in Chapter 452.

cǎo
grass
Introduced in Chapter 68.

草地 *cǎodì*
lawn; grassy ground
Introduced in Chapter 226.

cǎoyuán
grassland; prairie
Introduced in Chapter 226.

céng
floor; storey
Introduced in Chapter 206.

céngjīng
once (in the past); at one time
Introduced in Chapter 261.

cèsuǒ
toilet; lavatory
Introduced in Chapter 192.

chà
to be short of; to (before the hour)
Introduced in Chapter 143.

chá
tea
Introduced in Chapter 39.

茶杯 *chábēi*
teacup
Introduced in Chapter 170.

chàbuduō
about; almost
Introduced in Chapter 205.

chàdiǎnr
nearly; almost
Introduced in Chapter 236.

chāduì
to jump the queue
Introduced in Chapter 360.

场 *chǎng*
measure word for a rainstorm; measure word for a game or a show
Introduced in Chapter 416.

长 *cháng*
long
Introduced in Chapter 61.

chángcháng
often
Introduced in Chapter 126.

长城 *Chángchéng*
the Great Wall
Introduced in Chapter 447.

chànggē
to sing
Introduced in Chapter 55.

chǎnghé
occasion; setting
Introduced in Chapter 360.

长假 *chángjià*
long holiday
Introduced in Chapter 339.

chángtú
long-distance
Introduced in Chapter 410.

chángwèi
stomach and gut; digestion
Introduced in Chapter 477.

chǎnshēng
to arise; to come about
Introduced in Chapter 538.

chǎo
to stir-fry
Introduced in Chapter 113.

吵 *chǎo*
noisy
Introduced in Chapter 129.

chǎofàn
fried rice
Introduced in Chapter 161.

chǎojià
to quarrel; to have a row
Introduced in Chapter 176.

cháoshī
damp; humid
Introduced in Chapter 218.

chāoshì
supermarket
Introduced in Chapter 100.

chāosù
to break the speed limit
Introduced in Chapter 421.

chāozhòng
overweight; over the weight limit
Introduced in Chapter 418.

cháyè
tea leaves
Introduced in Chapter 166.

chāzi
fork
Introduced in Chapter 170.

chāzuò
power socket
Introduced in Chapter 426.

车 *chē*
car; vehicle
Introduced in Chapter 44.

车道 *chēdào*
traffic lane
Introduced in Chapter 420.

chēfèi
fare for a ride
Introduced in Chapter 410.

chēhuò
traffic accident; car crash
Introduced in Chapter 296.

chēng
to weigh on a scale
Introduced in Chapter 526.

城 *chéng*
town; walled city
Introduced in Chapter 446.

成本 *chéngběn*
production cost; cost
Introduced in Chapter 384.

成才 *chéngcái*
to make something of oneself
Introduced in Chapter 512.

chénggōng
to succeed
Introduced in Chapter 394.

成果 *chéngguǒ*
fruits of work; achievements
Introduced in Chapter 395.

chéngjì
results; marks
Introduced in Chapter 249.

成家 *chéngjiā*
to marry and settle down
Introduced in Chapter 399.

chéngkè
passenger
Introduced in Chapter 402.

chéngliáng
to sit in the cool (out of the sun)
Introduced in Chapter 519.

成名 *chéngmíng*
to become famous
Introduced in Chapter 512.

chéngnián
to come of age; fully grown
Introduced in Chapter 317.

chéngqiáng
city wall; the wall round a city
Introduced in Chapter 446.

chéngrèn
to admit; to own up
Introduced in Chapter 310.

chéngshì
city
Introduced in Chapter 81.

chéngshí
honest
Introduced in Chapter 273.

chéngshú
to ripen; to be ripe
Introduced in Chapter 516.

成为 *chéngwéi*
to become
Introduced in Chapter 384.

chéngwùyuán
flight attendant; cabin crew
Introduced in Chapter 414.

成长 *chéngzhǎng*
to mature (as a person)
Introduced in Chapter 401.

成真 *chéngzhēn*
to become reality (of a wish)
Introduced in Chapter 536.

车票 *chēpiào*
train or bus ticket
Introduced in Chapter 196.

车速 *chēsù*
speed of a vehicle
Introduced in Chapter 421.

chēwèi
parking space
Introduced in Chapter 420.

chēxiāng
railway carriage
Introduced in Chapter 402.

车站 *chēzhàn*
station; stop
Introduced in Chapter 106.

吃 *chī*
to eat
Introduced in Chapter 38.

chídào
to be late; to arrive late
Introduced in Chapter 83.

chījīng
surprised; taken aback
Introduced in Chapter 271.

chīkuī
to come off worse; to lose out
Introduced in Chapter 539.

chǐmǎ
clothing size; shoe size
Introduced in Chapter 199.

chīsù
to eat no meat; to be vegetarian
Introduced in Chapter 451.

chítáng
pond
Introduced in Chapter 246.

chīyào
to take medicine
Introduced in Chapter 228.

chōngdiàn
to charge a battery
Introduced in Chapter 109.

chōngdòng
impulsive; rash
Introduced in Chapter 469.

chǒngwù
pet
Introduced in Chapter 229.

重新 *chóngxīn*
anew; over again from the start
Introduced in Chapter 295.

chōngzhí
to top up (a card or a phone)
Introduced in Chapter 212.

chóngzi
insect; bug
Introduced in Chapter 242.

chōujiǎng
to draw for prizes; to hold a prize draw
Introduced in Chapter 530.

chōukòng
to find time (for something)
Introduced in Chapter 388.

chōuqiān
to draw lots
Introduced in Chapter 528.

chōuti
drawer
Introduced in Chapter 186.

chuán
boat; ship
Introduced in Chapter 227.

chuān
to wear; to put on
Introduced in Chapter 59.

chuáncāng
ship's cabin
Introduced in Chapter 412.

chuáng
bed
Introduced in Chapter 87.

chuángdān
bed sheet
Introduced in Chapter 427.

chuānghu
window
Introduced in Chapter 159.

chuǎnghuò
to get into trouble; to cause a mess
Introduced in Chapter 539.

chuānglián
curtain
Introduced in Chapter 181.

chuàngyè
to start a business; to found an enterprise
Introduced in Chapter 513.

chuàngzuò
to create (art or writing)
Introduced in Chapter 503.

传话 *chuánhuà*
to carry messages between people
Introduced in Chapter 328.

传球 *chuánqiú*
to pass the ball
Introduced in Chapter 499.

chuánrǎn
to pass on (an illness); to be catching
Introduced in Chapter 245.

传说 *chuánshuō*
legend; folk tale
Introduced in Chapter 328.

chuántǒng
tradition
Introduced in Chapter 340.

船长 *chuánzhǎng*
ship's captain
Introduced in Chapter 411.

chūchāi
to travel for work; to go on a business trip
Introduced in Chapter 191.

出错 *chūcuò*
to slip up; to go wrong
Introduced in Chapter 356.

chūfā
to set off; to depart
Introduced in Chapter 155.

chúfáng
kitchen
Introduced in Chapter 101.

chúfēi
unless
Introduced in Chapter 396.

出国 *chūguó*
to go abroad
Introduced in Chapter 191.

出海 *chūhǎi*
to go out to sea
Introduced in Chapter 433.

chūhàn
to sweat
Introduced in Chapter 220.

chuīfēngjī
hair dryer
Introduced in Chapter 164.

chūjí
elementary; for beginners
Introduced in Chapter 496.

chūjìng
to leave a country
Introduced in Chapter 417.

出口 *chūkǒu*
exit; way out
Introduced in Chapter 112.

chǔlǐ
to deal with
Introduced in Chapter 297.

chūmén
to go out
Introduced in Chapter 43.

春光 *chūnguāng*
the beauty of spring; spring sunshine
Introduced in Chapter 519.

春节 *Chūnjié*
the Spring Festival; Chinese New Year
Introduced in Chapter 137.

chūnlián
Spring Festival couplets
Introduced in Chapter 334.

春天 *chūntiān*
spring
Introduced in Chapter 131.

春晚 *Chūnwǎn*
the Spring Festival Gala
Introduced in Chapter 333.

春游 *chūnyóu*
spring outing
Introduced in Chapter 431.

出气 *chūqì*
to vent one's anger; to take it out on someone
Introduced in Chapter 464.

出去 *chūqù*
to go outside; to go out of here
Introduced in Chapter 183.

出入 *chūrù*
to go in and out
Introduced in Chapter 405.

出色 *chūsè*
outstanding; excellent
Introduced in Chapter 451.

出生 *chūshēng*
to be born
Introduced in Chapter 254.

chúshī
chef; professional cook
Introduced in Chapter 488.

出事 *chūshì*
to have an accident; for something to go wrong
Introduced in Chapter 232.

Chúxī
lunar New Year's Eve
Introduced in Chapter 333.

出现 *chūxiàn*
to appear; to turn up
Introduced in Chapter 236.

chūxíng
to get about; to go out on a journey
Introduced in Chapter 429.

chūyuàn
to leave hospital
Introduced in Chapter 241.

chūzūchē
taxi
Introduced in Chapter 44.

cì
time (one occurrence)
Introduced in Chapter 140.

cídiǎn
dictionary
Introduced in Chapter 104.

cízhí
to resign; to quit a job
Introduced in Chapter 276.

从 *cóng*
from
Introduced in Chapter 155.

cóng'ér
and thereby; and in this way
Introduced in Chapter 538.

cóngcǐ
from then on
Introduced in Chapter 345.

cónglái
ever; (before 没) never once
Introduced in Chapter 150.

cōngming
clever; bright
Introduced in Chapter 123.

从前 *cóngqián*
once upon a time; in the past
Introduced in Chapter 178.

从小 *cóngxiǎo*
since childhood; since I was little
Introduced in Chapter 269.

cúnkuǎn
savings (in the bank)
Introduced in Chapter 387.

cūnmín
villager
Introduced in Chapter 440.

cúnqián
to put money by; to put money in the bank
Introduced in Chapter 195.

村长 *cūnzhǎng*
village head
Introduced in Chapter 440.

cūnzi
village
Introduced in Chapter 246.

cuò
wrong; mistaken
Introduced in Chapter 121.

错过 *cuòguò*
to miss a chance; to miss a train
Introduced in Chapter 356.

cuòwù
mistake; error
Introduced in Chapter 356.

cūxīn
careless
Introduced in Chapter 273.

大 *dà*
big; large, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 13.

打电话 *dǎ diànhuà*
to phone; to make a phone call
Introduced in Chapter 63.

dǎ pēntì
to sneeze
Introduced in Chapter 222.

dǎ zhāohu
to say hello to someone
Introduced in Chapter 361.

dá'àn
answer to a question
Introduced in Chapter 268.

dǎbài
to defeat; to beat (an opponent)
Introduced in Chapter 262.

dǎban
to dress up; to get dressed up
Introduced in Chapter 164.

打包 *dǎbāo*
to pack food to take away
Introduced in Chapter 120.

dāchē
to get a lift
Introduced in Chapter 429.

打车 *dǎchē*
to take a taxi
Introduced in Chapter 409.

dàchuángfáng
room with a double bed
Introduced in Chapter 426.

dádào
to attain (a goal); to reach a level
Introduced in Chapter 513.

dǎdǔ
to make a bet
Introduced in Chapter 528.

dàfang
generous; open-handed
Introduced in Chapter 265.

打工 *dǎgōng*
to work part-time; to have a part-time job
Introduced in Chapter 255.

dǎgǔ
to play the drums
Introduced in Chapter 257.

dàhǎi
the open sea
Introduced in Chapter 238.

dài
to bring; to take along
Introduced in Chapter 89.

dàiyù
pay and conditions (of a job)
Introduced in Chapter 486.

dàizi
bag; sack
Introduced in Chapter 119.

dǎjià
to fight; to get into a fistfight
Introduced in Chapter 312.

大家 *dàjiā*
everyone, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 13.

打开 *dǎkāi*
to open; to switch on
Introduced in Chapter 171.

dǎléi
to thunder
Introduced in Chapter 136.

大量 *dàliàng*
a large amount of; in large amounts
Introduced in Chapter 526.

大米 *dàmǐ*
uncooked rice; rice grain
Introduced in Chapter 161.

dàn
bland; weak (in taste)
Introduced in Chapter 172.

dànǎo
brain
Introduced in Chapter 477.

dānchéng
one way (of a ticket or a trip)
Introduced in Chapter 284.

当 *dāng*
to work as; to be (a job or a role)
Introduced in Chapter 287.

dàngāo
cake
Introduced in Chapter 75.

dāngchǎng
on the spot; there and then
Introduced in Chapter 295.

当地 *dāngdì*
of that place; in the place in question
Introduced in Chapter 316.

当家 *dāngjiā*
to run the household
Introduced in Chapter 509.

当面 *dāngmiàn*
to someone's face; in person
Introduced in Chapter 355.

当年 *dāngnián*
back then; in those years
Introduced in Chapter 322.

dāngrán
of course
Introduced in Chapter 217.

dāngshí
at that time; then
Introduced in Chapter 187.

当天 *dàngtiān*
that same day; on that very day
Introduced in Chapter 295.

当心 *dāngxīn*
to watch out; to look out
Introduced in Chapter 366.

当真 *dàngzhēn*
to take it seriously; to take at face value
Introduced in Chapter 373.

dànjì
off season; quiet season
Introduced in Chapter 432.

dānrénjiān
single room
Introduced in Chapter 200.

但是 *dànshì*
but; however
Introduced in Chapter 369.

dǎnxiǎo
timid; easily scared
Introduced in Chapter 463.

dānxīn
to worry
Introduced in Chapter 125.

但愿 *dànyuàn*
let us hope that; if only
Introduced in Chapter 535.

dǎnzi
courage; nerve
Introduced in Chapter 332.

dào
to arrive; to reach
Introduced in Chapter 72.

dāo
knife
Introduced in Chapter 101.

dǎo
to topple over; to fall down (of a thing)
Introduced in Chapter 176.

岛 *dǎo*
island
Introduced in Chapter 444.

到时候 *dào shíhou*
when the time comes
Introduced in Chapter 391.

dàochē
to reverse the car; to back up
Introduced in Chapter 420.

dàochù
everywhere
Introduced in Chapter 211.

dàodá
to reach a destination; to arrive
Introduced in Chapter 196.

dàodé
morality; ethics
Introduced in Chapter 359.

dàodǐ
on earth (in a question)
Introduced in Chapter 372.

dǎoháng
to navigate by satnav
Introduced in Chapter 422.

道理 *dàoli*
sense; the reason something makes sense
Introduced in Chapter 353.

dǎoméi
to be out of luck; to have bad luck
Introduced in Chapter 529.

到期 *dàoqī*
to fall due; to run out
Introduced in Chapter 389.

dàoqiàn
to apologise
Introduced in Chapter 275.

dàotián
rice paddy; paddy field
Introduced in Chapter 439.

dǎoyóu
tour guide
Introduced in Chapter 213.

dǎozhì
to result in something bad
Introduced in Chapter 537.

dǎpò
to break; to smash
Introduced in Chapter 187.

dǎqiú
to play ball
Introduced in Chapter 56.

dǎrǎo
to disturb
Introduced in Chapter 209.

大人 *dàren*
adult; grown-up
Introduced in Chapter 266.

dǎsǎn
to put up an umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 518.

打扫 *dǎsǎo*
to clean (a room); to sweep
Introduced in Chapter 133.

dàshēng
loudly; in a loud voice
Introduced in Chapter 362.

大事 *dàshì*
big deal; important matter
Introduced in Chapter 276.

dǎsuàn
to plan to; to intend
Introduced in Chapter 148.

dàtáng
hotel lobby
Introduced in Chapter 425.

dǎting
to ask around; to inquire
Introduced in Chapter 217.

dǎtōng
to get through on the phone
Introduced in Chapter 320.

dàwù
thick fog
Introduced in Chapter 518.

大小 *dàxiǎo*
size
Introduced in Chapter 108.

大学 *dàxué*
university; college, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 13.

大学生 *dàxuésheng*
university student, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 13.

大衣 *dàyī*
overcoat; coat
Introduced in Chapter 165.

dǎyìn
to print out
Introduced in Chapter 212.

dāying
to agree (to a request); to say yes
Introduced in Chapter 275.

大约 *dàyuē*
approximately; roughly (a time or number)
Introduced in Chapter 390.

dǎzhàng
to fight a war; to go into battle
Introduced in Chapter 327.

dǎzhé
to give a discount; to be on sale
Introduced in Chapter 122.

dǎzhēn
to have an injection; to give one
Introduced in Chapter 228.

打字 *dǎzì*
to type
Introduced in Chapter 204.

得 *de*
the particle between a verb and how well it is done
Introduced in Chapter 152.

的 *de*
de — the particle that puts an owner in front of what is owned, and carries no tone
Introduced in Chapter 23.

的话 *dehuà*
if (closing a condition)
Introduced in Chapter 288.

děi
to have to; must
Introduced in Chapter 282.

得救 *déjiù*
to be rescued; to be saved from danger
Introduced in Chapter 299.

dēng
lamp; light
Introduced in Chapter 87.

děng
to wait; to wait for
Introduced in Chapter 48.

dēngjì
to register officially
Introduced in Chapter 316.

dēngjī
to board a plane
Introduced in Chapter 413.

dēngjīkǒu
departure gate
Introduced in Chapter 415.

dēngjīpái
boarding pass
Introduced in Chapter 415.

dēnglóng
lantern
Introduced in Chapter 335.

dēnglù
to log in
Introduced in Chapter 204.

dēngpào
light bulb
Introduced in Chapter 174.

dēngshān
to climb a mountain
Introduced in Chapter 435.

dēngtǎ
lighthouse
Introduced in Chapter 444.

第二天 *dì'èr tiān*
the next day; the following day
Introduced in Chapter 279.

点 *diǎn*
o'clock; dot
Introduced in Chapter 48.

diǎncài
to order food
Introduced in Chapter 71.

diànchí
battery
Introduced in Chapter 208.

diànfèi
electricity bill
Introduced in Chapter 383.

电工 *diàngōng*
electrician
Introduced in Chapter 259.

电话 *diànhuà*
telephone; phone call
Introduced in Chapter 63.

diǎnjī
to click (on a screen)
Introduced in Chapter 204.

diànnǎo
computer
Introduced in Chapter 58.

diànshì
television
Introduced in Chapter 109.

diàntái
radio station
Introduced in Chapter 290.

diàntī
lift; elevator
Introduced in Chapter 192.

点头 *diǎntóu*
to nod
Introduced in Chapter 228.

点心 *diǎnxin*
dim sum; light snacks and pastries
Introduced in Chapter 120.

diànyǐng
film; movie
Introduced in Chapter 55.

diànyǐngyuàn
cinema
Introduced in Chapter 190.

diàochá
to investigate
Introduced in Chapter 311.

diàotóu
to turn round (in a car); to make a U-turn
Introduced in Chapter 424.

diàoyú
to go fishing
Introduced in Chapter 141.

dìbǎn
the floor of a room; floorboards
Introduced in Chapter 522.

dìdi
younger brother
Introduced in Chapter 32.

地点 *dìdiǎn*
place; venue
Introduced in Chapter 207.

dié
to fold
Introduced in Chapter 133.

dìfang
place
Introduced in Chapter 81.

dǐkànglì
resistance to illness
Introduced in Chapter 484.

地理 *dìlǐ*
geography
Introduced in Chapter 492.

dìng
to make a booking; to order
Introduced in Chapter 120.

dìnghūn
to get engaged
Introduced in Chapter 305.

dìngjū
to settle down; to make a place your home
Introduced in Chapter 313.

定期 *dìngqī*
at regular intervals; periodically
Introduced in Chapter 390.

dìqiú
the earth; our planet
Introduced in Chapter 380.

地区 *dìqū*
region; area (of a country)
Introduced in Chapter 398.

dìtiě
underground; metro
Introduced in Chapter 106.

dìtú
map
Introduced in Chapter 211.

diū
to lose (a thing)
Introduced in Chapter 116.

dìxíng
terrain; lie of the land
Introduced in Chapter 436.

dìyī
first
Introduced in Chapter 140.

dìzhèn
earthquake
Introduced in Chapter 300.

dìzhǐ
address
Introduced in Chapter 120.

dǒng
to understand
Introduced in Chapter 53.

东北 *dōngběi*
northeast; the Northeast (of China)
Introduced in Chapter 422.

dōngbian
the east; on the east side
Introduced in Chapter 117.

dòngchē
D-class bullet train
Introduced in Chapter 407.

dòngjiāng
to be frozen stiff
Introduced in Chapter 514.

东南 *dōngnán*
southeast
Introduced in Chapter 423.

dǒngshì
sensible; grown-up for one's age (of a child)
Introduced in Chapter 508.

dōngtiān
winter
Introduced in Chapter 131.

dòngwù
animal
Introduced in Chapter 223.

dōngxi
thing; things
Introduced in Chapter 42.

都 *dōu*
all; both
Introduced in Chapter 94.

dòufu
tofu; bean curd
Introduced in Chapter 177.

dòushā
sweet bean paste
Introduced in Chapter 341.

dú
to read aloud; to study
Introduced in Chapter 54.

duǎn
short in length; brief
Introduced in Chapter 61.

duànliàn
to exercise; to work out
Introduced in Chapter 135.

duǎnxìn
text message
Introduced in Chapter 118.

dǔchē
traffic jam; to be stuck in traffic
Introduced in Chapter 95.

dùchuán
ferry
Introduced in Chapter 411.

对 *duì*
duì — 'right', and on its own the commonest way to agree in spoken Mandarin
Introduced in Chapter 26.

duì'àn
the far bank; the opposite bank
Introduced in Chapter 442.

对不起 *duìbuqǐ*
sorry
Introduced in Chapter 64.

duìfāng
the other side; the other party
Introduced in Chapter 348.

duìhuàn
to exchange money
Introduced in Chapter 419.

duìmiàn
opposite; across from
Introduced in Chapter 82.

对手 *duìshǒu*
opponent; rival
Introduced in Chapter 262.

duìzhǎng
team captain; team leader
Introduced in Chapter 499.

dùjià
to go on holiday; to spend a holiday
Introduced in Chapter 184.

dùn
to stew
Introduced in Chapter 168.

多 *duō*
many; much; a lot of
Introduced in Chapter 431.

多大 *duō dà*
how old (asking a person's age)
Introduced in Chapter 78.

duōjiǔ
how long (a time)
Introduced in Chapter 286.

duōkuī
it is thanks to; luckily for
Introduced in Chapter 541.

多年 *duōnián*
for many years
Introduced in Chapter 343.

多少 *duōshao*
how much; how many
Introduced in Chapter 41.

多谢 *duōxiè*
many thanks; thanks a lot
Introduced in Chapter 457.

duǒyǔ
to shelter from the rain
Introduced in Chapter 234.

多云 *duōyún*
cloudy
Introduced in Chapter 219.

dúshēngzǐnǚ
only child
Introduced in Chapter 508.

读音 *dúyīn*
pronunciation; how a character is read
Introduced in Chapter 249.

dùzi
belly; tummy
Introduced in Chapter 230.

è
hungry
Introduced in Chapter 38.

èmèng
nightmare
Introduced in Chapter 463.

二 *èr*
two
Introduced in Chapter 3.

ěrduo
ear
Introduced in Chapter 52.

儿歌 *érgē*
nursery rhyme; children's song
Introduced in Chapter 504.

二十 *èrshí*
twenty — two ten, and the same ten words now reach ninety-nine
Introduced in Chapter 21.

二手 *èrshǒu*
second-hand
Introduced in Chapter 386.

儿子 *érzi*
son, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 12.

étóu
forehead
Introduced in Chapter 472.

fābiǎo
to publish an article; to make public
Introduced in Chapter 292.

fādāi
to stare blankly; to be lost in a daze
Introduced in Chapter 466.

fādǒu
to tremble; to shiver
Introduced in Chapter 463.

发光 *fāguāng*
to give off light; to shine
Introduced in Chapter 517.

发火 *fāhuǒ*
to lose one's temper
Introduced in Chapter 464.

fákuǎn
to impose a fine; a penalty fine
Introduced in Chapter 312.

fǎlǜ
law; the law
Introduced in Chapter 363.

发明 *fāmíng*
to invent; an invention
Introduced in Chapter 291.

fán
annoyed; fed up
Introduced in Chapter 458.

饭 *fàn*
cooked rice; meal
Introduced in Chapter 38.

fǎnbó
to argue back; to refute
Introduced in Chapter 353.

fàndiàn
restaurant
Introduced in Chapter 44.

fǎnduì
to be against; to oppose
Introduced in Chapter 270.

fànfǎ
to break the law
Introduced in Chapter 363.

fàng
to put; to place
Introduced in Chapter 89.

fàng gēzi
to stand someone up
Introduced in Chapter 397.

fāngbiàn
convenient; handy
Introduced in Chapter 129.

房东 *fángdōng*
landlord; landlady
Introduced in Chapter 203.

方法 *fāngfǎ*
a way to solve a problem; means
Introduced in Chapter 457.

fàngjià
to have time off; to go on holiday
Introduced in Chapter 137.

fángjiān
room
Introduced in Chapter 57.

fángkǎ
room key card
Introduced in Chapter 425.

fàngqì
to give up
Introduced in Chapter 366.

fàngqíng
to clear up (of the sky)
Introduced in Chapter 219.

fángshàishuāng
sunscreen
Introduced in Chapter 444.

fāngshì
a way of doing things; a mode
Introduced in Chapter 385.

fàngsōng
to relax; to loosen
Introduced in Chapter 184.

fànguǎn
restaurant
Introduced in Chapter 182.

fāngxiàng
direction; way
Introduced in Chapter 117.

fàngxīn
to stop worrying; to be at ease
Introduced in Chapter 125.

fàngxué
to finish school for the day; (of a school) to let out
Introduced in Chapter 249.

fāngyán
dialect
Introduced in Chapter 436.

fángzi
house
Introduced in Chapter 57.

fángzū
rent for a home
Introduced in Chapter 203.

fānyì
to translate; to interpret
Introduced in Chapter 488.

fǎnzhèng
anyway; in any case
Introduced in Chapter 372.

fànzuì
to commit a crime
Introduced in Chapter 308.

发票 *fāpiào*
official receipt
Introduced in Chapter 428.

fāshāo
to have a fever
Introduced in Chapter 130.

fāshēng
to happen; to take place
Introduced in Chapter 167.

fāsòng
to send electronically; to send a message or an email
Introduced in Chapter 201.

fāxiàn
to discover; to find out
Introduced in Chapter 236.

fāyá
to sprout; to bud
Introduced in Chapter 237.

fāyán
to become inflamed
Introduced in Chapter 240.

fāyǎng
to itch
Introduced in Chapter 480.

fāzhǎn
to develop; to expand
Introduced in Chapter 374.

féi
loose; baggy (of clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 199.

飞 *fēi*
to fly
Introduced in Chapter 413.

fēicháng
extremely; very
Introduced in Chapter 77.

fēijī
aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 72.

飞快 *fēikuài*
very fast; as fast as flying
Introduced in Chapter 413.

fēixíng
flight; flying (of an aircraft)
Introduced in Chapter 416.

féizào
soap
Introduced in Chapter 105.

fèn
measure word for a serving; portion
Introduced in Chapter 161.

fēn
minute; to divide
Introduced in Chapter 48.

fèndòu
to struggle (towards a goal)
Introduced in Chapter 513.

féng
to sew; to stitch
Introduced in Chapter 521.

fēng
wind
Introduced in Chapter 66.

fēngjǐng
scenery; landscape
Introduced in Chapter 226.

fēngsú
custom; social custom
Introduced in Chapter 338.

风味 *fēngwèi*
local flavour; distinctive taste
Introduced in Chapter 449.

fēngxiǎn
risk
Introduced in Chapter 389.

风衣 *fēngyī*
a windbreaker; a light coat against the wind
Introduced in Chapter 218.

fěnhóng
pink
Introduced in Chapter 139.

fēnlèi
to sort into kinds
Introduced in Chapter 381.

fènnù
furious; indignant
Introduced in Chapter 464.

fēnshǒu
to break up; to end a relationship
Introduced in Chapter 307.

fēnxī
to analyse
Introduced in Chapter 351.

fēnxiǎng
to share
Introduced in Chapter 343.

fēnzhōng
minute (a length of time)
Introduced in Chapter 143.

fǒurèn
to deny
Introduced in Chapter 355.

fù
to pay
Introduced in Chapter 114.

fú
to help up; to hold up with a hand
Introduced in Chapter 301.

fǔdǎo
to tutor; to give guidance
Introduced in Chapter 493.

fùjìn
nearby; in the area
Introduced in Chapter 111.

父母 *fùmǔ*
parents; one's mother and father
Introduced in Chapter 509.

父女 *fùnǚ*
father and daughter
Introduced in Chapter 507.

fūqī
married couple; husband and wife
Introduced in Chapter 507.

父亲 *fùqīn*
father (the formal word)
Introduced in Chapter 511.

fúwùtái
service desk; information desk
Introduced in Chapter 454.

fúwùyuán
waiter; attendant
Introduced in Chapter 92.

fùxí
to revise; to go over again
Introduced in Chapter 121.

fùyìn
to photocopy
Introduced in Chapter 212.

fùzé
to be in charge (of)
Introduced in Chapter 263.

父子 *fùzǐ*
father and son
Introduced in Chapter 507.

改 *gǎi*
to alter; to amend
Introduced in Chapter 392.

该 *gāi*
it's time to; should (by now)
Introduced in Chapter 282.

改变 *gǎibiàn*
to make different (a plan or a habit)
Introduced in Chapter 392.

gǎiháng
to change careers
Introduced in Chapter 401.

改口 *gǎikǒu*
to change one's tune; to take back what one said
Introduced in Chapter 392.

改名 *gǎimíng*
to change the name (of)
Introduced in Chapter 392.

改期 *gǎiqī*
to change the date (of an event)
Introduced in Chapter 392.

gǎiqiān
to change a booking; to change a ticket to another train
Introduced in Chapter 406.

gǎishàn
to make conditions better
Introduced in Chapter 541.

gǎitiān
some other day; another time
Introduced in Chapter 234.

gǎizhèng
to put a mistake right
Introduced in Chapter 356.

gǎndào
to feel
Introduced in Chapter 252.

gǎndòng
to move; to touch someone's heart
Introduced in Chapter 271.

gāngcái
a moment ago
Introduced in Chapter 126.

gǎngkǒu
port; harbour
Introduced in Chapter 412.

gāngqín
piano
Introduced in Chapter 110.

gànhuó
to get the jobs done; to work
Introduced in Chapter 160.

gǎnjí
to go to market day; to go to a country market
Introduced in Chapter 440.

gǎnjī
to feel deeply grateful
Introduced in Chapter 457.

gānjìng
clean
Introduced in Chapter 93.

感觉 *gǎnjué*
to feel (how something seems); a feeling
Introduced in Chapter 286.

gǎnkuài
quickly; hurry
Introduced in Chapter 145.

gǎnmào
to catch a cold; a cold
Introduced in Chapter 130.

感情 *gǎnqíng*
affection between people; feelings for each other
Introduced in Chapter 459.

gǎnrǎn
to become infected
Introduced in Chapter 481.

gǎnshàng
to catch in time; to make it onto a train
Introduced in Chapter 391.

gānxǐ
to dry-clean
Introduced in Chapter 215.

感想 *gǎnxiǎng*
impressions afterwards; thoughts
Introduced in Chapter 346.

gǎnxiè
to thank (warmly)
Introduced in Chapter 77.

gānzào
dry air; dry (of weather or skin)
Introduced in Chapter 218.

gāo
tall; high
Introduced in Chapter 61.

gàobié
to say goodbye; to take leave
Introduced in Chapter 336.

gāofēng
peak (of traffic); rush hour
Introduced in Chapter 409.

高级 *gāojí*
advanced; high-level
Introduced in Chapter 496.

高考 *gāokǎo*
college entrance exam
Introduced in Chapter 494.

高手 *gāoshǒu*
expert; master (at something)
Introduced in Chapter 260.

gàosu
to tell
Introduced in Chapter 214.

高速 *gāosù*
expressway
Introduced in Chapter 421.

gāotiě
high-speed railway
Introduced in Chapter 402.

gāoxìng
happy; glad
Introduced in Chapter 51.

gāoyuán
plateau; highland
Introduced in Chapter 437.

高中 *gāozhōng*
senior high school
Introduced in Chapter 248.

gē
song
Introduced in Chapter 128.

个 *gè*
gè — the measure word, and the fact that a Mandarin number cannot touch a noun without one
Introduced in Chapter 24.

gébì
next door
Introduced in Chapter 427.

gēbo
arm
Introduced in Chapter 474.

gēcí
the words of a song; lyrics
Introduced in Chapter 504.

gēge
elder brother
Introduced in Chapter 32.

给 *gěi*
to give; to, for
Introduced in Chapter 89.

gēmí
fan (of a singer)
Introduced in Chapter 506.

gēn
with; and; (gēn … yíyàng) the same as
Introduced in Chapter 153.

gēnběn
not in the least; (not) at all
Introduced in Chapter 538.

gèng
even more; still more
Introduced in Chapter 153.

gēnjù
basis; what something rests on
Introduced in Chapter 350.

gēshǒu
singer
Introduced in Chapter 257.

格外 *géwài*
more than usual; unusually
Introduced in Chapter 525.

个性 *gèxìng*
individuality; a strong personality
Introduced in Chapter 467.

géyīn
soundproofing; soundproof
Introduced in Chapter 378.

个子 *gèzi*
height; build (of a person)
Introduced in Chapter 124.

格子 *gézi*
a checked pattern; squares
Introduced in Chapter 527.

gōngchǎng
factory
Introduced in Chapter 487.

gōngchéngshī
engineer
Introduced in Chapter 488.

gōnggòng
public; shared by everyone
Introduced in Chapter 360.

公交 *gōngjiāo*
public transport
Introduced in Chapter 408.

gōngjiāochē
city bus
Introduced in Chapter 106.

gōngjīn
kilogram
Introduced in Chapter 526.

gōngjù
tool
Introduced in Chapter 208.

公里 *gōnglǐ*
kilometre
Introduced in Chapter 205.

公路 *gōnglù*
highway; main road
Introduced in Chapter 421.

gōngrén
worker
Introduced in Chapter 80.

gōngsī
company; firm
Introduced in Chapter 80.

gōngxǐ
to congratulate
Introduced in Chapter 337.

gōngyuán
park
Introduced in Chapter 100.

公正 *gōngzhèng*
fair; impartial
Introduced in Chapter 362.

gōngzhǔ
princess
Introduced in Chapter 329.

gōngzī
pay; wages
Introduced in Chapter 255.

gōngzuò
to work; job
Introduced in Chapter 35.

gòu
enough
Introduced in Chapter 188.

gǒu
dog
Introduced in Chapter 67.

gòuwù
to go shopping; to do some shopping
Introduced in Chapter 434.

guà
to hang; to hang up
Introduced in Chapter 174.

guàduàn
to hang up the phone; to end a call
Introduced in Chapter 320.

guāfēng
to be windy
Introduced in Chapter 136.

guàhào
to register at a clinic; to register at a hospital
Introduced in Chapter 231.

guǎi
to turn a corner
Introduced in Chapter 111.

怪 *guài*
to put the blame on someone
Introduced in Chapter 539.

guàibude
no wonder
Introduced in Chapter 235.

怪事 *guàishì*
a strange business; an odd thing
Introduced in Chapter 539.

guāliǎn
to have a shave; to shave one's face
Introduced in Chapter 164.

guān
to shut; to close; to switch off
Introduced in Chapter 65.

guānbì
to shut down; to be shut to the public
Introduced in Chapter 432.

guāndiǎn
point of view; standpoint
Introduced in Chapter 346.

光 *guāng*
light from the sun or a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 517.

guǎngbō
to broadcast; a broadcast
Introduced in Chapter 292.

guǎngchǎng
public square
Introduced in Chapter 194.

guǎngchǎngwǔ
square dancing
Introduced in Chapter 376.

guǎnggào
advert; advertisement
Introduced in Chapter 156.

guàngjiē
to stroll the shops; to go window-shopping
Introduced in Chapter 141.

guānguāng
to go sightseeing
Introduced in Chapter 430.

关机 *guānjī*
to switch off (a phone or a computer)
Introduced in Chapter 198.

guānjiàn
key; crucial point
Introduced in Chapter 370.

guànjūn
champion
Introduced in Chapter 501.

guǎnlǐ
to manage; to be in charge of
Introduced in Chapter 490.

guānmén
to close (for the day); to shut the door
Introduced in Chapter 155.

guānxīn
to care about
Introduced in Chapter 123.

guānzhòng
viewers; spectators; the people watching a show
Introduced in Chapter 292.

guānzhù
to follow a story closely; to keep an eye on
Introduced in Chapter 293.

guàshī
to report the loss of (a card or document)
Introduced in Chapter 285.

古城 *gǔchéng*
ancient walled town; old town
Introduced in Chapter 446.

古代 *gǔdài*
ancient times
Introduced in Chapter 323.

gūdān
lonely; on one's own
Introduced in Chapter 459.

古怪 *gǔguài*
eccentric; peculiar (of a person)
Introduced in Chapter 540.

guì
expensive
Introduced in Chapter 42.

鬼 *guǐ*
ghost
Introduced in Chapter 332.

guīdìng
rule; regulation
Introduced in Chapter 209.

guìhuā
osmanthus flowers
Introduced in Chapter 342.

guījù
rules of conduct; manners
Introduced in Chapter 340.

guīzé
rules of a game; set procedure
Introduced in Chapter 359.

guìzi
cupboard; cabinet
Introduced in Chapter 175.

gūjì
to reckon; to make a rough guess
Introduced in Chapter 346.

gǔjì
historic site
Introduced in Chapter 430.

gùkè
customer
Introduced in Chapter 202.

古老 *gǔlǎo*
ancient; age-old
Introduced in Chapter 321.

gǔlì
to encourage
Introduced in Chapter 368.

guō
pot; pan; wok
Introduced in Chapter 170.

国歌 *guógē*
national anthem
Introduced in Chapter 504.

国画 *guóhuà*
traditional Chinese painting
Introduced in Chapter 502.

guójì
international
Introduced in Chapter 419.

guójí
citizenship; the country one belongs to
Introduced in Chapter 455.

国家 *guójiā*
country; nation
Introduced in Chapter 326.

过节 *guòjié*
to celebrate a festival
Introduced in Chapter 338.

过来 *guòlai*
to come over
Introduced in Chapter 180.

guòmǐn
to be allergic
Introduced in Chapter 480.

guónèi
domestic (inside the country)
Introduced in Chapter 419.

guònián
to celebrate the New Year
Introduced in Chapter 137.

过期 *guòqī*
to be out of date; to have expired
Introduced in Chapter 455.

国庆 *Guóqìng*
National Day
Introduced in Chapter 339.

过去 *guòqù*
in the past; to go over (there)
Introduced in Chapter 150.

果然 *guǒrán*
sure enough; as expected
Introduced in Chapter 301.

果树 *guǒshù*
fruit tree
Introduced in Chapter 516.

国外 *guówài*
abroad; overseas
Introduced in Chapter 261.

国王 *guówáng*
king
Introduced in Chapter 330.

guǒyuán
orchard
Introduced in Chapter 439.

guǒzhī
fruit juice
Introduced in Chapter 102.

古人 *gǔrén*
the ancients; people of long ago
Introduced in Chapter 321.

gùshi
story
Introduced in Chapter 250.

古书 *gǔshū*
ancient book; old book
Introduced in Chapter 321.

gǔtou
bone
Introduced in Chapter 477.

故意 *gùyì*
on purpose; deliberately
Introduced in Chapter 309.

gǔzhǎng
to clap; to applaud
Introduced in Chapter 257.

gǔzhé
to break a bone
Introduced in Chapter 301.

gùzhí
stubborn
Introduced in Chapter 470.

还 *hái*
still; yet
Introduced in Chapter 154.

hái xíng
hái xíng — 'not bad', the honest middle answer between fine and tired
Introduced in Chapter 30.

hǎibiān
the seaside; the seashore
Introduced in Chapter 227.

hǎiguān
customs at the border
Introduced in Chapter 417.

hǎilàng
sea wave; a wave of the sea
Introduced in Chapter 445.

hàipà
to be scared
Introduced in Chapter 236.

还是 *háishi*
or (in a question)
Introduced in Chapter 154.

海外 *hǎiwài*
overseas; beyond the sea
Introduced in Chapter 433.

hǎixiān
seafood
Introduced in Chapter 450.

hàixiū
shy; bashful
Introduced in Chapter 265.

háizi
child
Introduced in Chapter 33.

hǎn
to shout; to call out
Introduced in Chapter 298.

hángbān
scheduled flight
Introduced in Chapter 196.

hángyè
line of business; industry
Introduced in Chapter 487.

hángzhànlóu
airport terminal
Introduced in Chapter 415.

hánlěng
bitterly cold (of a climate)
Introduced in Chapter 515.

汉语 *hànyǔ*
the Chinese language; Mandarin
Introduced in Chapter 16.

汉字 *hànzì*
Chinese character; Han character
Introduced in Chapter 16.

号 *hào*
day of the month; number (in a series)
Introduced in Chapter 189.

好 *hǎo*
good, well
Introduced in Chapter 1.

好不好 *hǎo bu hǎo*
is it good, written from three characters already yours and no new shape at all
Introduced in Chapter 19.

好吃 *hǎochī*
tasty; good to eat
Introduced in Chapter 69.

hǎochu
benefit; advantage
Introduced in Chapter 373.

好喝 *hǎohē*
nice to drink
Introduced in Chapter 71.

hǎojiǔ
a long time; ages
Introduced in Chapter 185.

好看 *hǎokàn*
good-looking or nice to look at
Introduced in Chapter 18.

好客 *hàokè*
hospitable
Introduced in Chapter 273.

hàomǎ
number (of a phone, a room); identifying number
Introduced in Chapter 63.

hǎopíng
good review; favourable comment
Introduced in Chapter 452.

hǎotīng
pleasant to hear
Introduced in Chapter 128.

hǎoxiàng
as if; to look like (a guess)
Introduced in Chapter 280.

好笑 *hǎoxiào*
funny
Introduced in Chapter 267.

好意 *hǎoyì*
good intentions; a kind thought
Introduced in Chapter 355.

hǎoyùn
good luck
Introduced in Chapter 337.

hǎozhuǎn
to take a turn for the better; to start to improve
Introduced in Chapter 483.

和 *hé*
hé — 'and' between two nouns, and never between two sentences
Introduced in Chapter 27.

喝 *hē*
to drink
Introduced in Chapter 39.

河 *hé*
river
Introduced in Chapter 442.

héfàn
boxed meal; packed lunch
Introduced in Chapter 182.

hēi
black; dark
Introduced in Chapter 60.

hējiǔ
to drink alcohol
Introduced in Chapter 239.

hèn
to hate deeply; to resent
Introduced in Chapter 462.

很 *hěn*
hěn — 'very', and the plain link Mandarin puts in front of an adjective
Introduced in Chapter 30.

很好 *hěn hǎo*
hěn hǎo — 'fine', the answer to how are you, and two third tones side by side
Introduced in Chapter 30.

和气 *héqi*
good-natured; pleasant to deal with
Introduced in Chapter 468.

héshì
right; suitable; a good fit
Introduced in Chapter 108.

hétong
contract; written agreement
Introduced in Chapter 203.

héyǐng
to have a group photo taken; to pose for a group photo
Introduced in Chapter 431.

hézi
box; small case
Introduced in Chapter 119.

hézuò
to work together; to cooperate
Introduced in Chapter 490.

hóng
red
Introduced in Chapter 60.

hǒng
to soothe a child; to coax
Introduced in Chapter 510.

红包 *hóngbāo*
red envelope
Introduced in Chapter 334.

hóngchá
black tea
Introduced in Chapter 166.

红火 *hónghuǒ*
prosperous; flourishing
Introduced in Chapter 334.

hónglǜdēng
traffic lights
Introduced in Chapter 194.

hòu
after; behind; later
Introduced in Chapter 82.

hòubèi
the back of the body
Introduced in Chapter 475.

hòubian
behind; at the back
Introduced in Chapter 111.

候车 *hòuchē*
to wait for a train or bus
Introduced in Chapter 402.

hòuchēshì
station waiting room
Introduced in Chapter 403.

后代 *hòudài*
descendants; later generations
Introduced in Chapter 325.

后果 *hòuguǒ*
consequences; what comes of it
Introduced in Chapter 297.

hòuhuǐ
to regret
Introduced in Chapter 187.

后来 *hòulái*
afterwards; later (in the past)
Introduced in Chapter 150.

后妈 *hòumā*
stepmother
Introduced in Chapter 509.

后天 *hòutiān*
the day after tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 147.

hóuzi
monkey
Introduced in Chapter 223.

hú
lake
Introduced in Chapter 226.

huā
flower
Introduced in Chapter 68.

话 *huà*
words; speech
Introduced in Chapter 53.

huábīng
to ice-skate
Introduced in Chapter 274.

huáchuán
to row a boat
Introduced in Chapter 246.

花店 *huādiàn*
florist's; flower shop
Introduced in Chapter 224.

huàfèi
phone charges
Introduced in Chapter 319.

huàhuà
to paint pictures; to draw
Introduced in Chapter 110.

huài
broken; bad
Introduced in Chapter 103.

huàichu
harm; downside
Introduced in Chapter 373.

huáiniàn
to cherish the memory of; to look back fondly on
Introduced in Chapter 322.

huáiyí
to suspect; to doubt
Introduced in Chapter 310.

huáiyùn
to be pregnant; to be expecting a baby
Introduced in Chapter 302.

画家 *huàjiā*
painter (an artist)
Introduced in Chapter 502.

huàn
to change; to exchange
Introduced in Chapter 108.

huán
to give back
Introduced in Chapter 64.

huánbǎo
eco-friendly
Introduced in Chapter 380.

huànchéng
to change trains or lines
Introduced in Chapter 402.

huáng
yellow
Introduced in Chapter 139.

huāng
flustered; in a panic
Introduced in Chapter 301.

huángdì
emperor
Introduced in Chapter 327.

huánghūn
twilight; the fading light of evening
Introduced in Chapter 517.

还价 *huánjià*
to offer a lower price back; to make a counter-offer
Introduced in Chapter 524.

huánjìng
environment; surroundings
Introduced in Chapter 380.

欢送 *huānsòng*
to give a send-off
Introduced in Chapter 336.

huānyíng
welcome
Introduced in Chapter 74.

huāqián
to spend money
Introduced in Chapter 188.

huáqiáo
overseas Chinese; a Chinese person settled abroad
Introduced in Chapter 433.

花生 *huāshēng*
peanut
Introduced in Chapter 237.

huásuàn
good value; worth it
Introduced in Chapter 386.

话题 *huàtí*
topic of conversation
Introduced in Chapter 354.

huáxuě
to ski
Introduced in Chapter 221.

huāyuán
garden
Introduced in Chapter 224.

huàzhǎn
art exhibition
Introduced in Chapter 502.

huàzhuāng
to put on make-up
Introduced in Chapter 164.

húdié
butterfly
Introduced in Chapter 224.

huí
to go back; to return
Introduced in Chapter 43.

huī
grey
Introduced in Chapter 139.

会 *huì*
can (having learned how)
Introduced in Chapter 90.

huíchéng
return journey; the journey back
Introduced in Chapter 428.

huídá
to answer
Introduced in Chapter 121.

回电 *huídiàn*
to call back; to return a call
Introduced in Chapter 319.

huífù
to reply (to a message)
Introduced in Chapter 157.

huīfù
to recover; to get back to normal
Introduced in Chapter 241.

回国 *huíguó*
to go home from abroad; to return to one's own country
Introduced in Chapter 191.

回来 *huílái*
to come back
Introduced in Chapter 191.

回去 *huíqù*
to go back there
Introduced in Chapter 191.

huíshōu
to recycle
Introduced in Chapter 381.

huíyì
to recall; to think back on
Introduced in Chapter 247.

回音 *huíyīn*
reply; echo
Introduced in Chapter 318.

huìyuán
a member of a club or a shop's scheme
Introduced in Chapter 527.

护理 *hùlǐ*
to care for the sick; to tend
Introduced in Chapter 482.

hūnlǐ
wedding
Introduced in Chapter 254.

hūnshā
wedding dress
Introduced in Chapter 307.

hūnyīn
marriage; the bond of marriage
Introduced in Chapter 317.

活 *huó*
to live; alive
Introduced in Chapter 302.

火车 *huǒchē*
train
Introduced in Chapter 72.

huǒchēzhàn
railway station
Introduced in Chapter 73.

huòdé
to win (a prize); to be awarded
Introduced in Chapter 501.

huódòng
an activity; an organised event
Introduced in Chapter 376.

活该 *huógāi*
it serves them right; serves you right
Introduced in Chapter 312.

huópō
full of life; vivacious
Introduced in Chapter 467.

火气 *huǒqì*
temper; anger
Introduced in Chapter 464.

huòshèng
to win a contest; to be victorious
Introduced in Chapter 500.

huǒzāi
big fire; a fire that destroys buildings
Introduced in Chapter 298.

huòzhě
or (in a statement)
Introduced in Chapter 154.

hùshi
nurse
Introduced in Chapter 231.

护送 *hùsòng*
to escort
Introduced in Chapter 443.

hútòng
lane; alley (in an old city)
Introduced in Chapter 446.

hūxī
to breathe
Introduced in Chapter 239.

hùxiāng
each other; mutually
Introduced in Chapter 375.

hùzhào
passport
Introduced in Chapter 116.

húzi
beard; moustache
Introduced in Chapter 233.

jì
to post; to send by post
Introduced in Chapter 118.

jǐ
how many; a few
Introduced in Chapter 48.

家 *jiā*
home or family, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 12.

jiābān
to work overtime
Introduced in Chapter 255.

jiǎbǎn
ship's deck
Introduced in Chapter 412.

家常菜 *jiāchángcài*
home cooking; everyday dishes
Introduced in Chapter 182.

家电 *jiādiàn*
household appliance
Introduced in Chapter 520.

家教 *jiājiào*
private tutor
Introduced in Chapter 493.

jiājù
furniture
Introduced in Chapter 175.

jiān
to fry (in a little oil)
Introduced in Chapter 113.

间 *jiān*
measure word for rooms
Introduced in Chapter 181.

jiānbǎng
shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 476.

见报 *jiànbào*
to appear in the papers; to make the papers
Introduced in Chapter 293.

jiǎnchá
to check; to examine
Introduced in Chapter 208.

jiānchí
to keep at it; to persist
Introduced in Chapter 366.

jiǎndān
simple
Introduced in Chapter 144.

jiǎndāo
scissors
Introduced in Chapter 186.

jiǎnféi
to lose weight; to diet
Introduced in Chapter 220.

jiāng
a great river; big river
Introduced in Chapter 442.

jiàngjià
to get cheaper; to come down in price
Introduced in Chapter 193.

jiǎngjià
to haggle
Introduced in Chapter 193.

jiǎngjiu
to be particular about
Introduced in Chapter 340.

jiānglái
in the future; some day
Introduced in Chapter 148.

jiǎnglǐ
to be reasonable; to listen to reason
Introduced in Chapter 351.

jiàngluò
to land; to come down onto the runway
Introduced in Chapter 413.

jiǎngpǐn
a prize you win; an award
Introduced in Chapter 530.

jiǎngshù
to tell about; to give an account of
Introduced in Chapter 325.

见鬼 *jiànguǐ*
how absurd; curse it
Introduced in Chapter 332.

jiàngwēn
to turn colder; to cool down
Introduced in Chapter 219.

jiànjiàn
gradually; little by little
Introduced in Chapter 315.

见解 *jiànjiě*
insight; considered view
Introduced in Chapter 367.

jiànkāng
healthy; health
Introduced in Chapter 239.

jiānkòng
security camera; CCTV
Introduced in Chapter 382.

jiànlì
to found; to set up
Introduced in Chapter 326.

jiǎnlì
CV; résumé
Introduced in Chapter 486.

jiànmiàn
to meet up; to see each other
Introduced in Chapter 84.

检票 *jiǎnpiào*
to check tickets
Introduced in Chapter 404.

jiānqiáng
strong; tough (in spirit)
Introduced in Chapter 468.

jiǎnshǎo
to reduce; to cut down
Introduced in Chapter 383.

jiànshēn
to work out; to keep fit
Introduced in Chapter 220.

jiǎnyā
to relieve stress
Introduced in Chapter 485.

jiànyì
to suggest
Introduced in Chapter 365.

jiānyù
prison
Introduced in Chapter 312.

jiāo
to teach
Introduced in Chapter 121.

jiǎo
foot
Introduced in Chapter 52.

叫 *jiào*
to be called; to call
Introduced in Chapter 34.

jiāo'ào
proud; full of oneself
Introduced in Chapter 470.

jiāohuā
to water the plants
Introduced in Chapter 142.

jiāojǐng
traffic police officer
Introduced in Chapter 311.

jiāoqū
suburbs; outskirts
Introduced in Chapter 441.

jiàoshì
classroom
Introduced in Chapter 79.

交通 *jiāotōng*
traffic; transport
Introduced in Chapter 409.

jiàoxǐng
to wake someone up
Introduced in Chapter 158.

jiǎoxìng
lucky by a fluke
Introduced in Chapter 531.

jiàoxun
hard lesson learned
Introduced in Chapter 356.

jiàoyù
to educate; to bring up (the young); education
Introduced in Chapter 493.

jiǎozi
dumpling
Introduced in Chapter 70.

jiàqī
holidays; time off
Introduced in Chapter 137.

jiàqián
price
Introduced in Chapter 156.

家人 *jiārén*
family members, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 12.

假日 *jiàrì*
holiday; day off
Introduced in Chapter 338.

假如 *jiǎrú*
supposing that
Introduced in Chapter 534.

jiātíng
household; a family unit
Introduced in Chapter 317.

jiāwù
housework
Introduced in Chapter 133.

jiāxiāng
hometown; native place
Introduced in Chapter 342.

jiāxīn
to get a pay rise; to raise someone's pay
Introduced in Chapter 491.

jiāyóu
to cheer someone on; come on!
Introduced in Chapter 262.

家长 *jiāzhǎng*
pupil's parent; parent of a schoolchild
Introduced in Chapter 248.

jiàzhào
driving licence
Introduced in Chapter 420.

jīchǎng
airport
Introduced in Chapter 73.

jìchéng
to inherit; to take over (from a parent)
Introduced in Chapter 330.

jìcún
to leave in safekeeping
Introduced in Chapter 215.

jīdàn
egg
Introduced in Chapter 40.

jìde
to remember
Introduced in Chapter 217.

jīdòng
excited; worked up
Introduced in Chapter 271.

jiè
to borrow; to lend
Introduced in Chapter 64.

jiébīng
to freeze over
Introduced in Chapter 243.

jiēdài
to receive visitors; to take care of guests
Introduced in Chapter 433.

jiéguǒ
in the end; as a result; a result
Introduced in Chapter 187.

jiéhūn
to get married
Introduced in Chapter 254.

jiējī
to meet someone off a plane
Introduced in Chapter 419.

节假日 *jiéjiàrì*
public holiday
Introduced in Chapter 432.

jiějie
elder sister
Introduced in Chapter 32.

jièjiǔ
to give up drinking
Introduced in Chapter 484.

jiéjú
ending
Introduced in Chapter 329.

jiějué
to solve; to settle
Introduced in Chapter 217.

jièkǒu
excuse (a poor reason)
Introduced in Chapter 397.

jiélùn
conclusion
Introduced in Chapter 371.

jiěmèi
sisters
Introduced in Chapter 508.

jiémù
programme; TV show
Introduced in Chapter 267.

节能 *jiénéng*
to save energy; energy-saving
Introduced in Chapter 385.

节气 *jiéqì*
solar term
Introduced in Chapter 340.

节日 *jiérì*
festival
Introduced in Chapter 137.

jièshào
to introduce
Introduced in Chapter 74.

jiěshì
to explain
Introduced in Chapter 268.

jiēshòu
to accept
Introduced in Chapter 275.

jiéshù
to come to an end; to finish
Introduced in Chapter 122.

解说 *jiěshuō*
to give a running commentary
Introduced in Chapter 431.

jièsù
to lodge with a local family; to stay the night at someone's home
Introduced in Chapter 440.

jièyān
to give up smoking
Introduced in Chapter 239.

节约 *jiéyuē*
to economise; to use sparingly
Introduced in Chapter 389.

jiézhàng
to settle the bill
Introduced in Chapter 524.

jiēzhe
next; straight after that
Introduced in Chapter 278.

jígé
to pass an exam
Introduced in Chapter 268.

jíhé
to gather; to assemble; to meet up as a group
Introduced in Chapter 434.

jīhū
very nearly; all but
Introduced in Chapter 531.

jìhuà
plan
Introduced in Chapter 207.

机会 *jīhuì*
chance; opportunity
Introduced in Chapter 276.

jìjié
season
Introduced in Chapter 131.

jíjiù
first aid
Introduced in Chapter 299.

jìn
near; close
Introduced in Chapter 62.

jǐn
tight
Introduced in Chapter 199.

进 *jìn*
to come in; to enter
Introduced in Chapter 74.

jìnbù
to improve; to make progress
Introduced in Chapter 260.

进城 *jìnchéng*
to go to town; to move to the city
Introduced in Chapter 446.

警报 *jǐngbào*
alarm; a warning siren
Introduced in Chapter 311.

jǐngchá
police officer; the police
Introduced in Chapter 216.

jīngcháng
regularly; often
Introduced in Chapter 162.

警车 *jǐngchē*
police car
Introduced in Chapter 311.

jǐngdiǎn
sight; place of interest
Introduced in Chapter 207.

经过 *jīngguò*
the sequence of events; what happened
Introduced in Chapter 306.

jīngjìcāng
economy class
Introduced in Chapter 414.

jìngjiǔ
to propose a toast
Introduced in Chapter 361.

Jīngjù
Beijing opera
Introduced in Chapter 506.

jīnglì
an experience (something lived through)
Introduced in Chapter 247.

jīnglǐ
manager
Introduced in Chapter 263.

jǐngqū
scenic area
Introduced in Chapter 430.

jìngrán
to my surprise; unexpectedly
Introduced in Chapter 315.

jīngshen
vigour; get-up-and-go
Introduced in Chapter 485.

jīngxǐ
pleasant surprise
Introduced in Chapter 462.

jīngyàn
experience; know-how
Introduced in Chapter 261.

jìngzi
mirror
Introduced in Chapter 105.

jìniàn
to commemorate; to honour the memory of
Introduced in Chapter 324.

jìniànpǐn
souvenir
Introduced in Chapter 247.

进来 *jìnlái*
to come inside; to come in
Introduced in Chapter 183.

jǐnliàng
as far as one can
Introduced in Chapter 534.

今年 *jīnnián*
this year
Introduced in Chapter 47.

jīnpái
gold medal
Introduced in Chapter 501.

进球 *jìnqiú*
to score a goal
Introduced in Chapter 498.

进入 *jìnrù*
to go into
Introduced in Chapter 405.

jìnshì
short-sighted
Introduced in Chapter 471.

今天 *jīntiān*
today
Introduced in Chapter 45.

进站 *jìnzhàn*
to pull into the station (of a train or bus)
Introduced in Chapter 407.

jǐnzhāng
nervous; tense
Introduced in Chapter 265.

jìnzhǐ
to forbid; no (on signs)
Introduced in Chapter 115.

机票 *jīpiào*
plane ticket
Introduced in Chapter 196.

jìrán
given that; now that
Introduced in Chapter 396.

jīròu
chicken meat; chicken (as food)
Introduced in Chapter 161.

jíshí
in time; promptly; before it was too late
Introduced in Chapter 299.

jíshǐ
even if
Introduced in Chapter 396.

jìshù
skill; technique
Introduced in Chapter 260.

jítā
guitar
Introduced in Chapter 128.

jiù
old (of things); no longer new
Introduced in Chapter 62.

九 *jiǔ*
nine — third tone, and a dip you have had since ni
Introduced in Chapter 20.

就 *jiù*
then; right away
Introduced in Chapter 288.

酒店 *jiǔdiàn*
big hotel
Introduced in Chapter 425.

jiùhùchē
ambulance
Introduced in Chapter 232.

救活 *jiùhuó*
to bring back to life
Introduced in Chapter 302.

救火 *jiùhuǒ*
to fight a fire; to put out a fire
Introduced in Chapter 298.

jiùmìng
help!; the cry for help
Introduced in Chapter 298.

救生衣 *jiùshēngyī*
life jacket
Introduced in Chapter 411.

就业 *jiùyè*
to find employment; to get a job
Introduced in Chapter 487.

jíxìngzi
an impatient sort; a hothead
Introduced in Chapter 469.

jìxù
to carry on; to continue
Introduced in Chapter 244.

jìyì
memory
Introduced in Chapter 344.

机长 *jīzhǎng*
plane's captain; pilot in command
Introduced in Chapter 413.

jìzhě
journalist; reporter
Introduced in Chapter 259.

jízhěn
emergency department; urgent treatment
Introduced in Chapter 482.

jìzhù
to commit to memory; to keep in mind
Introduced in Chapter 304.

juān
to donate
Introduced in Chapter 375.

juéde
to find (that); to feel; to think (that)
Introduced in Chapter 144.

juédìng
to decide; a decision
Introduced in Chapter 184.

juésài
final (of a competition)
Introduced in Chapter 500.

juéwàng
to give up all hope; to despair
Introduced in Chapter 533.

jūgōng
to bow
Introduced in Chapter 361.

jùhuì
get-together; party
Introduced in Chapter 173.

jùjué
to refuse; to turn down
Introduced in Chapter 264.

jùlí
distance
Introduced in Chapter 205.

jǔlì
to give an example
Introduced in Chapter 369.

jūmín
resident (of a place)
Introduced in Chapter 377.

jùshuō
it is said that; reportedly
Introduced in Chapter 345.

jǔxíng
to hold a ceremony; to hold an event
Introduced in Chapter 306.

kāfēi
coffee
Introduced in Chapter 55.

kāi
to open; to switch on
Introduced in Chapter 65.

开车 *kāichē*
to drive
Introduced in Chapter 72.

kāichú
to fire; to dismiss (from a job or school)
Introduced in Chapter 490.

开船 *kāichuán*
to set sail
Introduced in Chapter 411.

开发 *kāifā*
to open up land for use
Introduced in Chapter 438.

kāifàng
to be open to the public
Introduced in Chapter 192.

开关 *kāiguān*
a light switch; a switch on a machine
Introduced in Chapter 520.

开花 *kāihuā*
to bloom; to flower
Introduced in Chapter 224.

开会 *kāihuì*
to have a meeting
Introduced in Chapter 157.

开机 *kāijī*
to turn a phone on; to switch on a phone or a computer
Introduced in Chapter 198.

kāilǎng
cheerful and outgoing
Introduced in Chapter 467.

开门 *kāimén*
to open (for business); to open the door
Introduced in Chapter 155.

kāishǐ
to begin; to start
Introduced in Chapter 122.

开水 *kāishuǐ*
boiled water; boiling water
Introduced in Chapter 166.

开通 *kāitōng*
to launch a new transport line
Introduced in Chapter 410.

开往 *kāiwǎng*
to be bound for a place
Introduced in Chapter 427.

开心 *kāixīn*
happy; in high spirits
Introduced in Chapter 252.

开学 *kāixué*
to start the school term
Introduced in Chapter 303.

kāiyào
to prescribe medicine
Introduced in Chapter 231.

看 *kàn*
to look at or watch, recovered without pinyin
Introduced in Chapter 18.

看病 *kànbìng*
to see a doctor
Introduced in Chapter 130.

看不起 *kànbuqǐ*
to look down on
Introduced in Chapter 361.

kàndài
to regard (in a certain way)
Introduced in Chapter 349.

看到 *kàndào*
to see; to catch sight of
Introduced in Chapter 151.

kàndǒng
to understand (on reading or watching)
Introduced in Chapter 151.

kànfǎ
view; opinion
Introduced in Chapter 256.

kāngfù
to get well again; to convalesce
Introduced in Chapter 483.

看见 *kànjiàn*
to see or catch sight of
Introduced in Chapter 18.

看来 *kànlai*
it seems; it looks as if
Introduced in Chapter 256.

看书 *kànshū*
to read a book or read books
Introduced in Chapter 18.

kànwàng
to call on; to visit (a person)
Introduced in Chapter 180.

kǎo
to roast; to bake
Introduced in Chapter 113.

kào'àn
to come in to shore
Introduced in Chapter 412.

考场 *kǎochǎng*
exam hall; exam room
Introduced in Chapter 495.

kàochuāng
next to the window
Introduced in Chapter 414.

kǎolǜ
to think something over; to consider
Introduced in Chapter 346.

考上 *kǎoshàng*
to get into (a school) by exam; to pass the entrance exam for
Introduced in Chapter 494.

考生 *kǎoshēng*
exam candidate
Introduced in Chapter 494.

kǎoshì
to take an exam
Introduced in Chapter 79.

kè
lesson; class
Introduced in Chapter 54.

kě
thirsty
Introduced in Chapter 39.

kě'ài
cute; lovable
Introduced in Chapter 123.

客车 *kèchē*
coach; long-distance bus
Introduced in Chapter 408.

客船 *kèchuán*
passenger ship
Introduced in Chapter 412.

客房 *kèfáng*
hotel guest room
Introduced in Chapter 425.

可见 *kějiàn*
which goes to show; so it is clear that
Introduced in Chapter 365.

kělè
cola
Introduced in Chapter 102.

kèmǎn
fully booked; with no vacancies
Introduced in Chapter 426.

kěn
to be willing to; to agree to
Introduced in Chapter 355.

kěndìng
for sure; without doubt
Introduced in Chapter 352.

kěnéng
maybe; possibly
Introduced in Chapter 147.

可怕 *kěpà*
frightening; awful
Introduced in Chapter 463.

客人 *kèrén*
guest
Introduced in Chapter 74.

可是 *kěshì*
but; yet
Introduced in Chapter 365.

késou
to cough
Introduced in Chapter 222.

kètīng
living room; sitting room
Introduced in Chapter 159.

课外 *kèwài*
outside class; extracurricular
Introduced in Chapter 497.

kěwàng
to thirst for; to crave
Introduced in Chapter 533.

kěxī
a pity; it's a shame
Introduced in Chapter 264.

可笑 *kěxiào*
ridiculous; laughable
Introduced in Chapter 367.

kēxuéjiā
scientist
Introduced in Chapter 488.

kěyǐ
may; can (with permission)
Introduced in Chapter 90.

kōng
empty
Introduced in Chapter 134.

kǒngpà
I'm afraid that; probably
Introduced in Chapter 264.

kōngqì
air
Introduced in Chapter 380.

kōngtiáo
air conditioner; air conditioning
Introduced in Chapter 171.

kòngwèi
empty seat
Introduced in Chapter 407.

口 *kǒu*
mouth
Introduced in Chapter 4.

口气 *kǒuqì*
tone of voice; way of saying something
Introduced in Chapter 357.

口试 *kǒushì*
oral exam
Introduced in Chapter 268.

口味 *kǒuwèi*
one's taste in food
Introduced in Chapter 449.

口音 *kǒuyīn*
accent
Introduced in Chapter 436.

kǒuzhào
face mask
Introduced in Chapter 245.

kū
to cry; to weep
Introduced in Chapter 51.

kǔ
bitter
Introduced in Chapter 172.

kuài
yuan; lump
Introduced in Chapter 41.

快 *kuài*
fast; quick
Introduced in Chapter 62.

kuàidì
express delivery; courier
Introduced in Chapter 201.

快乐 *kuàilè*
joyful; happy
Introduced in Chapter 75.

快速 *kuàisù*
rapid; high-speed
Introduced in Chapter 422.

kuàizi
chopsticks
Introduced in Chapter 101.

kuǎnshì
style; design
Introduced in Chapter 210.

kùzi
trousers
Introduced in Chapter 59.

là
spicy; hot
Introduced in Chapter 71.

lā
to pull
Introduced in Chapter 112.

lā dùzi
to have diarrhoea; to have an upset stomach
Introduced in Chapter 240.

来 *lái*
to come
Introduced in Chapter 36.

láibují
to run out of time
Introduced in Chapter 83.

láidejí
to still have time (to do something)
Introduced in Chapter 391.

来电 *láidiàn*
incoming call
Introduced in Chapter 319.

来回 *láihuí*
round trip
Introduced in Chapter 406.

来往 *láiwǎng*
to come and go
Introduced in Chapter 427.

来自 *láizì*
to come from
Introduced in Chapter 308.

lājī
rubbish
Introduced in Chapter 142.

lājītǒng
rubbish bin
Introduced in Chapter 186.

lán
blue
Introduced in Chapter 60.

làngfèi
to waste
Introduced in Chapter 383.

lánqiú
basketball
Introduced in Chapter 135.

lǎo
old
Introduced in Chapter 35.

lǎobǎn
boss; owner (of a business)
Introduced in Chapter 255.

老公 *lǎogōng*
hubby; husband (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 272.

lǎohǔ
tiger
Introduced in Chapter 223.

láojià
may I trouble you (asking a favour)
Introduced in Chapter 457.

lǎojiā
home town; family home
Introduced in Chapter 184.

lǎoshī
teacher
Introduced in Chapter 35.

了 *le*
le after a verb: the event is finished — and this is aspect, not tense
Introduced in Chapter 25.

lèguān
optimistic
Introduced in Chapter 465.

lèi
lèi — 'tired', and asked with 吗 like any other statement
Introduced in Chapter 30.

léiyǔ
thunderstorm
Introduced in Chapter 514.

lěng
cold
Introduced in Chapter 51.

冷菜 *lěngcài*
cold starter; cold dishes (on a menu)
Introduced in Chapter 182.

冷静 *lěngjìng*
calm; cool-headed
Introduced in Chapter 466.

离 *lí*
from; away from (in distance)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

里 *lǐ*
inside; in
Introduced in Chapter 81.

liàng
to hang out to dry
Introduced in Chapter 179.

两 *liǎng*
two (of something)
Introduced in Chapter 88.

liángkuai
pleasantly cool
Introduced in Chapter 136.

liánlei
to drag someone into trouble
Introduced in Chapter 540.

脸色 *liǎnsè*
complexion; the colour of one's face
Introduced in Chapter 472.

liànxí
to practise
Introduced in Chapter 121.

liánxì
to get in touch with; to contact
Introduced in Chapter 285.

了不起 *liǎobuqǐ*
amazing; remarkable
Introduced in Chapter 368.

了解 *liǎojiě*
to know in depth; to find out about
Introduced in Chapter 367.

liáotiān
to chat
Introduced in Chapter 84.

lǐbian
inside; in
Introduced in Chapter 85.

lièchēyuán
train attendant
Introduced in Chapter 403.

lǐfà
to get a haircut
Introduced in Chapter 212.

líhūn
to divorce
Introduced in Chapter 307.

理解 *lǐjiě*
to understand someone's reasons; to sympathize
Introduced in Chapter 367.

líkāi
to leave a place
Introduced in Chapter 107.

lǐmào
good manners; politeness
Introduced in Chapter 358.

līn
to carry in the hand (by a handle)
Introduced in Chapter 453.

líng
zero
Introduced in Chapter 132.

língchén
the small hours; before dawn
Introduced in Chapter 178.

língqián
small change; loose coins
Introduced in Chapter 188.

língshòu
to sell retail
Introduced in Chapter 523.

lìngwài
besides; in addition
Introduced in Chapter 369.

língxià
below zero
Introduced in Chapter 221.

línjū
neighbour
Introduced in Chapter 176.

línshí
at the last minute; for the time being
Introduced in Chapter 391.

línyǔ
to get caught in the rain
Introduced in Chapter 514.

力气 *lìqi*
physical strength
Introduced in Chapter 474.

lìshǐ
history
Introduced in Chapter 321.

六 *liù*
six — the sixth number, and the first one past where this book stopped
Introduced in Chapter 20.

liú bítì
to have a runny nose
Introduced in Chapter 480.

liúchuán
to be handed down; to spread
Introduced in Chapter 328.

liùgǒu
to walk the dog
Introduced in Chapter 229.

liújí
to repeat a school year
Introduced in Chapter 496.

liúlèi
to shed tears
Introduced in Chapter 314.

liúlì
fluent
Introduced in Chapter 152.

liúniàn
to keep as a souvenir
Introduced in Chapter 434.

liúxià
to leave behind
Introduced in Chapter 324.

liúxuè
to bleed
Introduced in Chapter 232.

liúxué
to study abroad
Introduced in Chapter 261.

liúyán
to leave a message
Introduced in Chapter 198.

lǐwù
present; gift
Introduced in Chapter 75.

理想 *lǐxiǎng*
ideal; aspiration
Introduced in Chapter 351.

lǐyóu
reason; grounds
Introduced in Chapter 235.

lìzi
an example
Introduced in Chapter 281.

lóng
dragon
Introduced in Chapter 328.

lóu
a building of several floors; a floor
Introduced in Chapter 206.

lóudào
stairwell; corridor (in a block of flats)
Introduced in Chapter 379.

lòushuǐ
to leak water
Introduced in Chapter 522.

lóutī
stairs; staircase
Introduced in Chapter 112.

lù
road; way
Introduced in Chapter 72.

lǜ
green
Introduced in Chapter 139.

luàn
messy; in a mess
Introduced in Chapter 362.

lùbiāo
road sign
Introduced in Chapter 424.

旅店 *lǚdiàn*
inn; small hotel
Introduced in Chapter 426.

lùfèi
travel costs; the cost of getting there
Introduced in Chapter 429.

路过 *lùguò*
to pass by (on the way somewhere)
Introduced in Chapter 283.

旅客 *lǚkè*
traveller; passenger on a long journey
Introduced in Chapter 403.

lùkǒu
crossroads; junction
Introduced in Chapter 111.

lùkuàng
road conditions
Introduced in Chapter 423.

luòbǎng
to fail an entrance exam
Introduced in Chapter 494.

luòyè
fallen leaves
Introduced in Chapter 516.

路人 *lùrén*
passer-by; stranger in the street
Introduced in Chapter 456.

lǜshī
lawyer
Introduced in Chapter 259.

lǚtú
journey
Introduced in Chapter 429.

lùxiàn
route
Introduced in Chapter 197.

lùyíng
to camp out
Introduced in Chapter 225.

lǚyóu
to travel; to tour
Introduced in Chapter 141.

lǚyóutuán
tour group
Introduced in Chapter 434.

吗 *ma*
the question particle, recovered without pinyin
Introduced in Chapter 19.

马 *mǎ*
horse
Introduced in Chapter 67.

máfan
to trouble; to bother
Introduced in Chapter 77.

mǎhu
sloppy; slapdash
Introduced in Chapter 470.

mài
to sell
Introduced in Chapter 42.

买 *mǎi*
to buy
Introduced in Chapter 40.

mǎidān
to pay the bill
Introduced in Chapter 114.

买家 *mǎijiā*
buyer
Introduced in Chapter 523.

卖家 *màijiā*
seller
Introduced in Chapter 523.

买卖 *mǎimai*
buying and selling for a living; a business deal
Introduced in Chapter 523.

马路 *mǎlù*
road; a street for traffic
Introduced in Chapter 194.

妈妈 *māma*
mum; mother
Introduced in Chapter 32.

màn
slow
Introduced in Chapter 53.

mǎn
full
Introduced in Chapter 134.

mǎnfēn
full marks
Introduced in Chapter 495.

máng
máng — 'busy', an adjective, so it takes 很 like 好
Introduced in Chapter 30.

mànxìng
chronic (of an illness)
Introduced in Chapter 483.

mǎnyì
satisfied; pleased
Introduced in Chapter 252.

mǎnzú
to meet (a requirement); to satisfy
Introduced in Chapter 399.

māo
cat
Introduced in Chapter 67.

máobìng
fault; bad habit
Introduced in Chapter 368.

máojīn
towel
Introduced in Chapter 105.

màoxiǎn
to take a risk
Introduced in Chapter 394.

máoyī
sweater; jumper
Introduced in Chapter 165.

màozi
hat; cap
Introduced in Chapter 59.

马上 *mǎshàng*
at once; right away
Introduced in Chapter 83.

mǎtou
pier; wharf
Introduced in Chapter 411.

每 *měi*
every; each
Introduced in Chapter 138.

méi guānxi
it doesn't matter; never mind
Introduced in Chapter 217.

Měiguó
America; the United States
Introduced in Chapter 36.

měihǎo
fine and happy (of a life or a future)
Introduced in Chapter 536.

méimao
eyebrow
Introduced in Chapter 472.

mèimei
younger sister
Introduced in Chapter 33.

没事 *méishì*
it's nothing; to be all right
Introduced in Chapter 167.

měitiān
every day
Introduced in Chapter 97.

没有 *méiyǒu*
not have; there is no
Introduced in Chapter 87.

门 *mén*
door; gate
Introduced in Chapter 65.

mèngjiàn
to dream of; to see in a dream
Introduced in Chapter 536.

mèngxiǎng
a dream (for your life); an aspiration
Introduced in Chapter 287.

ménjìn
door entry system; a card-entry door
Introduced in Chapter 379.

门口 *ménkǒu*
doorway; entrance
Introduced in Chapter 74.

ménlíng
doorbell
Introduced in Chapter 522.

门票 *ménpiào*
admission ticket
Introduced in Chapter 213.

mēnrè
hot and stuffy; muggy
Introduced in Chapter 218.

miànbāo
bread
Introduced in Chapter 40.

miǎnde
so as not to; lest
Introduced in Chapter 538.

miǎnfèi
free (of charge)
Introduced in Chapter 156.

面前 *miànqián*
in front of someone; in someone's presence
Introduced in Chapter 175.

面试 *miànshì*
to have an interview (for a job); interview
Introduced in Chapter 276.

miǎnshuì
duty-free; tax-free
Introduced in Chapter 417.

miàntiáo
noodles
Introduced in Chapter 70.

面子 *miànzi*
face; your standing in others' eyes
Introduced in Chapter 358.

miǎo
second (of time)
Introduced in Chapter 143.

miáotiao
slim; slender
Introduced in Chapter 233.

mǐfàn
cooked rice
Introduced in Chapter 38.

mìfēng
bee; honeybee
Introduced in Chapter 224.

mílù
to lose your way; to get lost
Introduced in Chapter 197.

mìmǎ
password; PIN
Introduced in Chapter 195.

明白 *míngbai*
to grasp a meaning; to understand; clear
Introduced in Chapter 214.

míngē
folk song
Introduced in Chapter 504.

名画 *mínghuà*
famous painting
Introduced in Chapter 502.

明年 *míngnián*
next year
Introduced in Chapter 47.

名人 *míngrén*
famous person; well-known figure
Introduced in Chapter 327.

míngtiān
tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 45.

明天见 *míngtiān jiàn*
see you tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 76.

名校 *míngxiào*
top school; famous university
Introduced in Chapter 512.

明星 *míngxīng*
star; celebrity
Introduced in Chapter 267.

míngxìnpiàn
postcard
Introduced in Chapter 318.

mìngyùn
fate; destiny
Introduced in Chapter 529.

名字 *míngzi*
name — literally the characters a name is made of
Introduced in Chapter 8.

mínzú
ethnic group; nationality
Introduced in Chapter 374.

mìshū
secretary
Introduced in Chapter 491.

míyǔ
riddle
Introduced in Chapter 335.

mìyuè
honeymoon
Introduced in Chapter 307.

mō
to stroke; to touch
Introduced in Chapter 229.

mòbānchē
last bus or train
Introduced in Chapter 405.

mófǎ
magic
Introduced in Chapter 331.

mùbiāo
a goal; a target
Introduced in Chapter 287.

mùdì
cemetery; graveyard
Introduced in Chapter 314.

母女 *mǔnǚ*
mother and daughter
Introduced in Chapter 509.

母亲 *mǔqīn*
mother (the formal word)
Introduced in Chapter 511.

母语 *mǔyǔ*
mother tongue
Introduced in Chapter 509.

ná
to take; to hold
Introduced in Chapter 103.

nǎ
which
Introduced in Chapter 36.

那 *nà*
that
Introduced in Chapter 37.

nǎge
which one
Introduced in Chapter 37.

那个 *nàge*
that one
Introduced in Chapter 37.

nǎinai
grandma on the father's side
Introduced in Chapter 253.

nàixīn
patient with people
Introduced in Chapter 258.

那么 *nàme*
so; that (much)
Introduced in Chapter 153.

男 *nán*
male
Introduced in Chapter 33.

南北 *nánběi*
north and south
Introduced in Chapter 423.

nánbian
the south; on the south side
Introduced in Chapter 117.

nánchī
tasting bad; horrible to eat
Introduced in Chapter 177.

难道 *nándào*
surely not (in a question)
Introduced in Chapter 397.

难得 *nándé*
rare; hard to come by
Introduced in Chapter 397.

南方 *nánfāng*
the south of the country; southern China
Introduced in Chapter 436.

nánguò
sad; upset
Introduced in Chapter 125.

男孩 *nánhái*
boy
Introduced in Chapter 266.

nánkàn
ugly
Introduced in Chapter 124.

nánmiǎn
bound to happen; hard to avoid
Introduced in Chapter 540.

男人 *nánrén*
man
Introduced in Chapter 33.

nánshòu
miserable; unwell
Introduced in Chapter 222.

难题 *nántí*
hard problem; difficult question
Introduced in Chapter 495.

难为情 *nánwéiqíng*
embarrassed
Introduced in Chapter 460.

南下 *nánxià*
to go south; to head down south
Introduced in Chapter 423.

nàoguǐ
to be haunted
Introduced in Chapter 332.

nàozhōng
alarm clock
Introduced in Chapter 145.

哪儿 *nǎr*
where?
Introduced in Chapter 86.

那儿 *nàr*
there
Introduced in Chapter 85.

哪些 *nǎxiē*
which ones
Introduced in Chapter 127.

那些 *nàxiē*
those
Introduced in Chapter 127.

呢 *ne*
ne — the particle that hands the question back, and turns one word into a whole turn
Introduced in Chapter 26.

nèiróng
content; what something is about
Introduced in Chapter 354.

能 *néng*
can; to be able to; to be allowed to
Introduced in Chapter 90.

nénglì
ability
Introduced in Chapter 260.

néngyuán
energy; sources of energy
Introduced in Chapter 383.

你 *nǐ*
you (one person)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

你好 *nǐ hǎo*
hello (literally "you good")
Introduced in Chapter 1.

你好吗 *nǐ hǎo ma*
how are you, written from three characters already yours
Introduced in Chapter 19.

你喜欢什么 *nǐ xǐhuan shénme*
asking what somebody likes, out of four words the book already had
Introduced in Chapter 28.

年 *nián*
year
Introduced in Chapter 47.

年代 *niándài*
decade; era
Introduced in Chapter 323.

年画 *niánhuà*
a new year print (hung at the spring festival)
Introduced in Chapter 503.

niánjì
age (of a person)
Introduced in Chapter 78.

niánjí
year; grade (at school)
Introduced in Chapter 248.

年假 *niánjià*
annual leave
Introduced in Chapter 263.

niánqīng
young
Introduced in Chapter 94.

niányèfàn
New Year's Eve dinner
Introduced in Chapter 333.

niǎo
bird
Introduced in Chapter 67.

你们 *nǐmen*
you all; you (more than one)
Introduced in Chapter 31.

nín
you (polite)
Introduced in Chapter 34.

nìngkě
would rather
Introduced in Chapter 534.

niúnǎi
milk
Introduced in Chapter 39.

niúròu
beef
Introduced in Chapter 161.

niǔshāng
to sprain
Introduced in Chapter 478.

nòng
to sort something out; to do; to handle
Introduced in Chapter 174.

nóngcūn
the countryside; a farming village
Introduced in Chapter 225.

nóngjiālè
farm stay; country guesthouse
Introduced in Chapter 439.

nóngmín
farmer
Introduced in Chapter 225.

女 *nǚ*
female; woman
Introduced in Chapter 12.

女儿 *nǚ'ér*
daughter, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 12.

nuǎnhuo
pleasantly warm; mild
Introduced in Chapter 218.

nuǎnqì
central heating
Introduced in Chapter 520.

女孩 *nǚhái*
girl
Introduced in Chapter 266.

nǔlì
hard-working; trying hard
Introduced in Chapter 249.

女人 *nǚrén*
woman
Introduced in Chapter 33.

ǒu'ěr
now and then; occasionally
Introduced in Chapter 162.

ǒurán
accidental; happening by chance
Introduced in Chapter 528.

pà
to be afraid of; to fear
Introduced in Chapter 51.

pá
to climb; to crawl
Introduced in Chapter 107.

pàichūsuǒ
local police station
Introduced in Chapter 308.

páiduì
to queue; to line up
Introduced in Chapter 192.

páiliàn
to rehearse
Introduced in Chapter 505.

pànduàn
to make a judgement; to judge
Introduced in Chapter 350.

pàng
fat; plump
Introduced in Chapter 94.

pángbiān
side; beside
Introduced in Chapter 81.

pàntou
something to look forward to
Introduced in Chapter 536.

pànwàng
to look forward to; to long for
Introduced in Chapter 461.

pánzi
plate; dish
Introduced in Chapter 101.

pǎobù
to run; to jog
Introduced in Chapter 56.

pàochá
to make tea (to steep the leaves)
Introduced in Chapter 166.

péi
to keep someone company; to go along with
Introduced in Chapter 163.

pèifú
to think highly of; to hold in high regard
Introduced in Chapter 461.

péiqián
to pay for damage
Introduced in Chapter 296.

pèng
to touch; to bump into
Introduced in Chapter 171.

pèngqiǎo
as luck would have it; coincidentally
Introduced in Chapter 528.

péngyou
friend
Introduced in Chapter 34.

piàn
to cheat; to con
Introduced in Chapter 309.

piān
measure word for essays and stories
Introduced in Chapter 251.

piányi
cheap
Introduced in Chapter 42.

piànzi
swindler; con man
Introduced in Chapter 309.

piào
ticket
Introduced in Chapter 73.

piàoliang
pretty; good-looking
Introduced in Chapter 59.

pīfā
to sell wholesale
Introduced in Chapter 523.

pífū
skin
Introduced in Chapter 233.

píjiǔ
beer
Introduced in Chapter 102.

píláo
worn out; fatigued
Introduced in Chapter 484.

pǐncháng
to taste; to sample
Introduced in Chapter 341.

píngguǒ
apple
Introduced in Chapter 40.

píngjìng
calm; peaceful inside
Introduced in Chapter 466.

pīngpāngqiú
table tennis; ping-pong
Introduced in Chapter 262.

píngshí
usually; ordinarily
Introduced in Chapter 146.

píngyuán
plain; flat open land
Introduced in Chapter 437.

píngzi
bottle
Introduced in Chapter 186.

pīpíng
to criticize
Introduced in Chapter 357.

píqi
temper; temperament
Introduced in Chapter 467.

pīzhǔn
to give official approval; to approve a plan
Introduced in Chapter 364.

pūchuáng
to make the bed
Introduced in Chapter 160.

qí
to ride (a bike or a horse)
Introduced in Chapter 106.

七 *qī*
seven — first tone, and a consonant English does not have
Introduced in Chapter 20.

qián
money
Introduced in Chapter 41.

前 *qián*
before; ago; front
Introduced in Chapter 78.

千 *qiān*
thousand
Introduced in Chapter 132.

qiánbāo
wallet; purse
Introduced in Chapter 116.

qiānbǐ
pencil
Introduced in Chapter 104.

前边 *qiánbian*
in front; ahead
Introduced in Chapter 111.

qiǎngjié
to rob by force
Introduced in Chapter 309.

qiǎngjiù
to fight to save a patient; to give emergency treatment
Introduced in Chapter 299.

qiānmíng
to sign your name
Introduced in Chapter 189.

qiānshōu
to sign for (a delivery)
Introduced in Chapter 215.

qiánshuǐ
to go diving; to dive under water
Introduced in Chapter 444.

qiántái
front desk; reception
Introduced in Chapter 206.

前天 *qiántiān*
the day before yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 167.

qiántú
prospects; future (of a person or job)
Introduced in Chapter 401.

千万 *qiānwàn*
be sure to (urging); whatever you do
Introduced in Chapter 393.

前往 *qiánwǎng*
to set out for a place
Introduced in Chapter 428.

qiānxū
modest
Introduced in Chapter 358.

前因后果 *qiányīn hòuguǒ*
the whole chain of causes and effects
Introduced in Chapter 540.

qiānzhèng
visa
Introduced in Chapter 213.

qiáo
bridge
Introduced in Chapter 246.

qiāomén
to knock at the door
Introduced in Chapter 176.

qìchē
motor vehicle; car
Introduced in Chapter 406.

qǐchuáng
to get up
Introduced in Chapter 50.

qícì
secondly; second in order
Introduced in Chapter 369.

起点 *qǐdiǎn*
starting point
Introduced in Chapter 408.

qiē
to cut; to slice
Introduced in Chapter 113.

qǐfēi
to take off (of a plane)
Introduced in Chapter 196.

qīfu
to bully; to pick on
Introduced in Chapter 508.

qíguài
strange; odd
Introduced in Chapter 216.

气候 *qìhòu*
climate
Introduced in Chapter 243.

气话 *qìhuà*
something said in anger
Introduced in Chapter 357.

期间 *qījiān*
period (during which); during
Introduced in Chapter 342.

起来 *qǐlai*
to get up; to stand up
Introduced in Chapter 158.

起名 *qǐmíng*
to name a baby; to give a name
Introduced in Chapter 303.

请 *qǐng*
please — a word you can say on its own, and a frame waiting to be filled
Introduced in Chapter 11.

qīngchè
crystal-clear (of water)
Introduced in Chapter 443.

qīngchén
early in the morning; at daybreak
Introduced in Chapter 519.

qīngchu
clear; clearly
Introduced in Chapter 152.

qīngdàn
light and mild (of food)
Introduced in Chapter 449.

请假 *qǐngjià*
to ask for time off
Introduced in Chapter 263.

请教 *qǐngjiào*
to seek advice (from someone who knows more)
Introduced in Chapter 493.

请客 *qǐngkè*
to pay for everyone; to treat (the others)
Introduced in Chapter 173.

qíngkuàng
situation; how things stand
Introduced in Chapter 294.

qínglǎng
clear and cloudless (of the sky)
Introduced in Chapter 518.

qīngnián
young people; youth
Introduced in Chapter 317.

qīngsōng
relaxed; light and easy
Introduced in Chapter 458.

qíngtiān
sunny day; fine weather
Introduced in Chapter 136.

请问 *qǐngwèn*
excuse me, may I ask
Introduced in Chapter 65.

qíngxù
emotions; spirits
Introduced in Chapter 458.

庆祝 *qìngzhù*
to celebrate
Introduced in Chapter 339.

qínkuài
diligent with chores; quick to pitch in
Introduced in Chapter 468.

qīnqi
relative; family member
Introduced in Chapter 253.

亲人 *qīnrén*
one's close family; one's nearest and dearest
Introduced in Chapter 511.

亲生 *qīnshēng*
one's own (by birth)
Introduced in Chapter 511.

亲手 *qīnshǒu*
with one's own hands
Introduced in Chapter 513.

亲自 *qīnzì*
personally (doing it oneself)
Introduced in Chapter 511.

qióng
poor (having little money)
Introduced in Chapter 375.

气人 *qìrén*
to be infuriating; to make people angry
Introduced in Chapter 464.

qíshí
actually; as a matter of fact
Introduced in Chapter 264.

qítā
other; the others
Introduced in Chapter 138.

球场 *qiúchǎng*
sports ground; pitch; court
Introduced in Chapter 498.

qiúduì
a sports team (in a ball game)
Introduced in Chapter 499.

qiúhūn
to propose marriage
Introduced in Chapter 305.

球门 *qiúmén*
goalmouth; goal (in football)
Introduced in Chapter 498.

qiúmí
sports fan
Introduced in Chapter 274.

球赛 *qiúsài*
a ball game (a football or basketball match)
Introduced in Chapter 500.

qiūtiān
autumn
Introduced in Chapter 131.

球星 *qiúxīng*
star player; sports star
Introduced in Chapter 501.

qiúyuán
a player in a ball game
Introduced in Chapter 499.

qiúzhù
to ask for help; to turn to someone for help
Introduced in Chapter 456.

期望 *qīwàng*
to expect much of someone; expectations
Introduced in Chapter 532.

qìwēn
air temperature
Introduced in Chapter 219.

起因 *qǐyīn*
what set it off; the starting cause
Introduced in Chapter 537.

qǐyuán
origin
Introduced in Chapter 345.

期中 *qīzhōng*
the middle of the term; midterm
Introduced in Chapter 495.

qīzi
wife
Introduced in Chapter 272.

去 *qù*
to go
Introduced in Chapter 43.

quàn
to urge; to try to persuade
Introduced in Chapter 364.

全部 *quánbù*
all of it; the whole
Introduced in Chapter 438.

全国 *quánguó*
the whole country; nationwide
Introduced in Chapter 381.

全家 *quánjiā*
the whole family
Introduced in Chapter 381.

全票 *quánpiào*
full-price ticket
Introduced in Chapter 432.

全天 *quántiān*
all day; round the clock
Introduced in Chapter 396.

全职 *quánzhí*
full-time (of a job)
Introduced in Chapter 489.

qūbié
difference
Introduced in Chapter 398.

取得 *qǔdé*
to achieve; to obtain (through effort)
Introduced in Chapter 395.

quēdiǎn
weak point; shortcoming
Introduced in Chapter 373.

quèdìng
to be certain; to settle on
Introduced in Chapter 390.

quèshí
indeed; it is true that
Introduced in Chapter 350.

qǔjuéyú
to depend on (a factor); to hinge on
Introduced in Chapter 398.

qúnzi
skirt
Introduced in Chapter 165.

qǔqián
to take out money
Introduced in Chapter 195.

去世 *qùshì*
to pass away
Introduced in Chapter 325.

qǔxiāo
to cancel; to call off
Introduced in Chapter 234.

ràngzuò
to give up one's seat (to someone)
Introduced in Chapter 376.

ránhòu
then; after that
Introduced in Chapter 150.

ràolù
to take a detour; to take the long way round
Introduced in Chapter 447.

rè
hot
Introduced in Chapter 51.

rě
to stir up trouble; to provoke
Introduced in Chapter 539.

rè'ài
to love deeply
Introduced in Chapter 277.

热点 *rèdiǎn*
hot topic; what everyone is talking about
Introduced in Chapter 290.

热门 *rèmén*
popular; all the rage
Introduced in Chapter 274.

人 *rén*
person
Introduced in Chapter 12.

rènao
lively; bustling
Introduced in Chapter 129.

rèncuò
to admit you were wrong
Introduced in Chapter 357.

rēng
to throw; to throw away
Introduced in Chapter 103.

réngrán
as before; even now
Introduced in Chapter 315.

人间 *rénjiān*
the human world
Introduced in Chapter 332.

rènkě
to give your approval; to accept as good
Introduced in Chapter 352.

人口 *rénkǒu*
population
Introduced in Chapter 374.

rènlǐng
to claim lost property
Introduced in Chapter 456.

人山人海 *rénshānrénhǎi*
huge crowds; a sea of people
Introduced in Chapter 433.

人生 *rénshēng*
a person's life; life from birth to death
Introduced in Chapter 316.

rènshi
to know someone; to recognise
Introduced in Chapter 34.

rèntóng
to share someone's view; to identify with
Introduced in Chapter 353.

rènwéi
to think; to hold a view
Introduced in Chapter 256.

rénxíngdào
pavement; sidewalk
Introduced in Chapter 447.

rènzhēn
conscientious; serious
Introduced in Chapter 123.

rèqíng
warm; welcoming
Introduced in Chapter 123.

rèshuǐqì
water heater
Introduced in Chapter 520.

热心 *rèxīn*
warm-hearted; eager to help
Introduced in Chapter 258.

日 *rì*
sun, and also day
Introduced in Chapter 4.

rìchéng
a day's schedule
Introduced in Chapter 391.

日出 *rìchū*
sunrise
Introduced in Chapter 435.

日记 *rìjì*
diary
Introduced in Chapter 304.

日期 *rìqī*
date
Introduced in Chapter 47.

日子 *rìzi*
day; days (of one's life)
Introduced in Chapter 178.

rónghuà
to melt; to thaw
Introduced in Chapter 514.

róngyì
easy
Introduced in Chapter 144.

ròu
meat
Introduced in Chapter 70.

ruǎn
soft
Introduced in Chapter 134.

ruǎnwò
soft sleeper
Introduced in Chapter 407.

如果 *rúguǒ*
if; in case
Introduced in Chapter 289.

rùjìng
to enter a country
Introduced in Chapter 417.

rùkǒu
entrance; way in
Introduced in Chapter 112.

如期 *rúqī*
as planned (on the agreed date)
Introduced in Chapter 390.

rùxué
to start school
Introduced in Chapter 304.

如意 *rúyì*
as one would wish
Introduced in Chapter 532.

如愿 *rúyuàn*
to get what one wished for
Introduced in Chapter 535.

rùzhù
to check in (at a hotel)
Introduced in Chapter 200.

sāi
to stuff in; to squeeze in
Introduced in Chapter 453.

三 *sān*
three
Introduced in Chapter 3.

sànbù
to take a walk
Introduced in Chapter 141.

sǎngzi
throat; voice
Introduced in Chapter 222.

sànxīn
to take one's mind off things; to unwind
Introduced in Chapter 439.

sǎodì
to sweep the floor
Introduced in Chapter 160.

sǎomǎ
to scan a code (to pay)
Introduced in Chapter 202.

sǎomù
to tend the family graves
Introduced in Chapter 340.

扫兴 *sǎoxìng*
deflated; with the fun spoiled
Introduced in Chapter 465.

sēnlín
forest
Introduced in Chapter 226.

shāchē
to put on the brakes; a brake
Introduced in Chapter 296.

shāfā
sofa
Introduced in Chapter 175.

shài
to dry in the sun
Introduced in Chapter 142.

shāmò
desert
Introduced in Chapter 437.

山 *shān*
mountain; hill
Introduced in Chapter 68.

山村 *shāncūn*
mountain village
Introduced in Chapter 440.

shǎndiàn
lightning
Introduced in Chapter 514.

shāndǐng
top of a mountain; summit
Introduced in Chapter 435.

上个月 *shàng ge yuè*
last month
Introduced in Chapter 148.

shàng'àn
to go ashore
Introduced in Chapter 445.

shāngbā
scar
Introduced in Chapter 479.

shàngbān
to go to work
Introduced in Chapter 80.

shàngbian
on top; above
Introduced in Chapter 86.

shāngchǎng
shopping centre
Introduced in Chapter 190.

上场 *shàngchǎng*
to take the field; to come on (to play)
Introduced in Chapter 500.

上车 *shàngchē*
to get on (a bus or train)
Introduced in Chapter 73.

shāngdiàn
shop
Introduced in Chapter 42.

上课 *shàngkè*
to have class; to start class
Introduced in Chapter 79.

伤口 *shāngkǒu*
wound; cut
Introduced in Chapter 478.

shāngliang
to talk it over together; to consult
Introduced in Chapter 348.

shànglóu
to go upstairs
Introduced in Chapter 206.

上路 *shànglù*
to set out on a journey; to hit the road
Introduced in Chapter 410.

上门 *shàngmén*
to call at the house (to do a job)
Introduced in Chapter 522.

上司 *shàngsi*
one's superior at work
Introduced in Chapter 491.

上网 *shàngwǎng*
to go online
Introduced in Chapter 109.

上午 *shàngwǔ*
morning (before noon)
Introduced in Chapter 49.

shāngxīn
sad; heartbroken
Introduced in Chapter 252.

上学 *shàngxué*
go to school; attend school, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 15.

上游 *shàngyóu*
upper reaches (of a river); upstream
Introduced in Chapter 442.

shǎngyuè
to enjoy the moon
Introduced in Chapter 342.

shànliáng
kind-hearted
Introduced in Chapter 468.

山区 *shānqū*
mountain area
Introduced in Chapter 437.

shānyáng
goat
Introduced in Chapter 242.

少 *shǎo*
few; not much
Introduced in Chapter 432.

少量 *shǎoliàng*
a small amount of
Introduced in Chapter 526.

少年 *shàonián*
teenage boy; teenager
Introduced in Chapter 323.

shāoshuǐ
to boil water
Introduced in Chapter 168.

sháozi
spoon; ladle
Introduced in Chapter 170.

shātān
sandy beach
Introduced in Chapter 227.

shé
snake
Introduced in Chapter 242.

shěbude
to hate to part with; to hate to leave
Introduced in Chapter 313.

社工 *shègōng*
social worker
Introduced in Chapter 376.

社会 *shèhuì*
society
Introduced in Chapter 375.

shèmén
to shoot at goal
Introduced in Chapter 498.

shēnbào
to declare goods at customs
Introduced in Chapter 417.

shēnfènzhèng
identity card
Introduced in Chapter 189.

shèng
to be left over
Introduced in Chapter 451.

身高 *shēngāo*
a person's height; body height
Introduced in Chapter 475.

生病 *shēngbìng*
to get sick; to fall ill
Introduced in Chapter 240.

shěngdiàn
to use little electricity; to save electricity
Introduced in Chapter 520.

shēnghuó
life; daily life
Introduced in Chapter 254.

生火 *shēnghuǒ*
to light a fire
Introduced in Chapter 441.

shēngmìng
the life of a living thing
Introduced in Chapter 300.

生气 *shēngqì*
to get angry
Introduced in Chapter 125.

shěngqián
to spend less; to save money
Introduced in Chapter 188.

生前 *shēngqián*
in someone's lifetime; while they were alive
Introduced in Chapter 314.

生人 *shēngrén*
stranger
Introduced in Chapter 378.

生日 *shēngrì*
birthday
Introduced in Chapter 75.

shēngxué
to go on to a higher school; to go on to further study
Introduced in Chapter 497.

生意 *shēngyi*
business; trade
Introduced in Chapter 341.

shēngyīn
sound; voice; noise
Introduced in Chapter 167.

shēngzhí
to get promoted
Introduced in Chapter 489.

生字 *shēngzì*
new character; a character not yet learned
Introduced in Chapter 251.

shénhuà
myth
Introduced in Chapter 328.

什么 *shénme*
what — the first question word in this book
Introduced in Chapter 9.

shēnqǐng
to apply for
Introduced in Chapter 455.

身上 *shēnshang*
on your person; on one's body
Introduced in Chapter 230.

shēntǐ
body; health
Introduced in Chapter 50.

shénxiān
immortal; supernatural being
Introduced in Chapter 331.

身心 *shēnxīn*
body and mind
Introduced in Chapter 485.

shēnyè
late at night; the dead of night
Introduced in Chapter 169.

shènzhì
even (going so far as)
Introduced in Chapter 371.

社区 *shèqū*
community; neighbourhood
Introduced in Chapter 377.

shétou
tongue
Introduced in Chapter 476.

十 *shí*
ten — and the last of the ten words that build every number to ninety-nine
Introduced in Chapter 20.

是 *shì*
to be — and how Mandarin says yes
Introduced in Chapter 5.

试 *shì*
to try; to try on
Introduced in Chapter 108.

是吗 *shì ma*
is that so, written from two characters already yours
Introduced in Chapter 19.

shībài
to fail
Introduced in Chapter 394.

市场 *shìchǎng*
market; marketplace
Introduced in Chapter 448.

世代 *shìdài*
for generations
Introduced in Chapter 325.

时代 *shídài*
era; age
Introduced in Chapter 324.

shīfu
skilled tradesman; master (and how you address one)
Introduced in Chapter 208.

事故 *shìgù*
accident
Introduced in Chapter 297.

shíhou
time; moment
Introduced in Chapter 46.

事后 *shìhòu*
after the event; in hindsight
Introduced in Chapter 295.

shìjiàn
incident; event (in the news)
Introduced in Chapter 291.

shíjiān
time; free time
Introduced in Chapter 83.

世界 *shìjiè*
world
Introduced in Chapter 326.

shíkèbiǎo
timetable
Introduced in Chapter 122.

shīmián
to be unable to sleep; to lie awake at night
Introduced in Chapter 480.

shìpín
video
Introduced in Chapter 204.

时期 *shíqī*
period; phase
Introduced in Chapter 323.

事情 *shìqing*
matter; affair
Introduced in Chapter 459.

市区 *shìqū*
the built-up part of a city; downtown
Introduced in Chapter 448.

时区 *shíqū*
time zone
Introduced in Chapter 388.

shìshí
fact
Introduced in Chapter 350.

shīshǒu
to lose one's grip; to do by a slip of the hand
Introduced in Chapter 531.

时速 *shísù*
speed per hour
Introduced in Chapter 424.

shítou
stone; rock
Introduced in Chapter 246.

shīwàng
disappointed
Introduced in Chapter 252.

shíxí
to do an internship; to work as a trainee
Introduced in Chapter 486.

shíxiàn
to come true; to make real
Introduced in Chapter 395.

事先 *shìxiān*
beforehand; in advance
Introduced in Chapter 317.

shīyè
to lose one's job; to be out of work
Introduced in Chapter 487.

事业 *shìyè*
career; life's work
Introduced in Chapter 487.

十一 *shíyī*
eleven — ten one, and the teens are finished in a sentence
Introduced in Chapter 21.

试衣间 *shìyījiān*
fitting room
Introduced in Chapter 210.

shìyìng
to adapt; to adjust to new surroundings
Introduced in Chapter 313.

shīyuē
to miss an appointment
Introduced in Chapter 388.

shìzhōngxīn
city centre
Introduced in Chapter 211.

shīzhǔ
the owner of a lost item
Introduced in Chapter 456.

shīzōng
to go missing
Introduced in Chapter 308.

shòu
thin; slim
Introduced in Chapter 94.

shōu
to receive; to accept
Introduced in Chapter 118.

手 *shǒu*
hand
Introduced in Chapter 52.

shǒubiǎo
wristwatch
Introduced in Chapter 116.

shōudào
to get something sent; to receive
Introduced in Chapter 201.

shōufèizhàn
toll gate
Introduced in Chapter 421.

手工 *shǒugōng*
handicraft; things made by hand
Introduced in Chapter 274.

shōuhuò
to bring in the harvest; to reap
Introduced in Chapter 515.

shòuhuòyuán
shop assistant
Introduced in Chapter 525.

shōují
to collect things
Introduced in Chapter 274.

手机 *shǒujī*
mobile phone
Introduced in Chapter 58.

shōujù
receipt
Introduced in Chapter 202.

shòupiàochù
ticket office
Introduced in Chapter 404.

shòupiàoyuán
ticket seller; bus conductor
Introduced in Chapter 409.

shōurù
income
Introduced in Chapter 387.

shòushāng
to get hurt; to be injured
Introduced in Chapter 232.

shōushi
to tidy up
Introduced in Chapter 133.

shǒushù
surgical operation
Introduced in Chapter 241.

shǒusuì
to keep the New Year vigil
Introduced in Chapter 333.

shǒutào
gloves
Introduced in Chapter 221.

shǒuxiān
first of all; to begin with
Introduced in Chapter 278.

手心 *shǒuxīn*
the palm of the hand
Introduced in Chapter 475.

shǒuxù
formalities; procedure
Introduced in Chapter 418.

shōuyíntái
checkout; till
Introduced in Chapter 202.

shǒuzhǐ
finger
Introduced in Chapter 474.

shǔ
to count
Introduced in Chapter 132.

书 *shū*
book, recovered without pinyin
Introduced in Chapter 18.

树 *shù*
tree
Introduced in Chapter 516.

shuā
to scrub; to brush clean
Introduced in Chapter 521.

shuài
handsome
Introduced in Chapter 124.

shuāi
to have a fall; to drop (and break)
Introduced in Chapter 187.

shuākǎ
to pay by card
Introduced in Chapter 114.

shuāng
a pair of (a measure word)
Introduced in Chapter 108.

shuāngbāotāi
twins
Introduced in Chapter 302.

shuāyá
to brush one's teeth
Introduced in Chapter 99.

书包 *shūbāo*
schoolbag
Introduced in Chapter 119.

书店 *shūdiàn*
bookshop
Introduced in Chapter 190.

书法 *shūfǎ*
calligraphy
Introduced in Chapter 503.

书房 *shūfáng*
study; a room for books and work
Introduced in Chapter 159.

shūfu
comfortable; well
Introduced in Chapter 96.

水 *shuǐ*
water
Introduced in Chapter 39.

shuì lǎnjiào
to sleep in; to lie in
Introduced in Chapter 145.

shuǐfèi
water bill
Introduced in Chapter 522.

shuǐguǒ
fruit
Introduced in Chapter 40.

shuìjiào
to sleep; to go to bed
Introduced in Chapter 50.

shuìzháo
to fall asleep
Introduced in Chapter 158.

shūjià
bookshelf
Introduced in Chapter 175.

shùlín
woods; a grove
Introduced in Chapter 516.

shùnlì
smooth; without a hitch
Introduced in Chapter 393.

shùnlù
on one's way
Introduced in Chapter 429.

说 *shuō*
to say; to speak
Introduced in Chapter 53.

shuōbudìng
perhaps; who knows
Introduced in Chapter 244.

说法 *shuōfa*
version of events; way of putting it
Introduced in Chapter 349.

shuōfú
to talk someone round; to persuade
Introduced in Chapter 353.

shuōhuǎng
to lie; to tell a lie
Introduced in Chapter 310.

说明 *shuōmíng*
to make something clear; to explain clearly
Introduced in Chapter 369.

说起 *shuōqǐ*
to mention; to bring up a subject
Introduced in Chapter 320.

shūshu
uncle; father's younger brother
Introduced in Chapter 272.

shūtóu
to comb one's hair
Introduced in Chapter 99.

shúxī
to know well; to be familiar with
Introduced in Chapter 316.

shùxué
maths; mathematics
Introduced in Chapter 492.

四 *sì*
four
Introduced in Chapter 3.

死 *sǐ*
to die
Introduced in Chapter 300.

死活 *sǐhuó*
no matter what; whatever anyone says
Introduced in Chapter 312.

sījī
driver
Introduced in Chapter 80.

四季 *sìjì*
the four seasons
Introduced in Chapter 515.

四季如春 *sìjì rú chūn*
mild like spring all year round (of a place)
Introduced in Chapter 519.

sīkǎo
to think hard; to reflect
Introduced in Chapter 347.

死心 *sǐxīn*
to give up hope
Introduced in Chapter 462.

死因 *sǐyīn*
cause of death
Introduced in Chapter 300.

sòng
to give as a present; to see off
Introduced in Chapter 75.

sònghuò
to deliver goods
Introduced in Chapter 215.

送客 *sòngkè*
to see a guest out
Introduced in Chapter 336.

sònglǐ
to give a present
Introduced in Chapter 336.

suàn
to calculate; to work out
Introduced in Chapter 140.

suān
sour
Introduced in Chapter 172.

sùcài
meatless dish; vegetable dish
Introduced in Chapter 451.

岁 *suì*
suì — years of age, and the sentence that says how old you are without a verb in it
Introduced in Chapter 27.

suíbiàn
as you like; casual
Introduced in Chapter 275.

suìdào
tunnel
Introduced in Chapter 424.

虽然 *suīrán*
although
Introduced in Chapter 371.

suíshí
at any time; whenever needed
Introduced in Chapter 393.

sùliàodài
plastic bag
Introduced in Chapter 186.

sūnnǚ
granddaughter
Introduced in Chapter 510.

sūnzi
grandson
Introduced in Chapter 510.

suōduǎn
to shorten
Introduced in Chapter 400.

suǒmén
to lock the door; to lock up
Introduced in Chapter 183.

suǒyǐ
so; therefore
Introduced in Chapter 96.

suǒyǒu
all; every
Introduced in Chapter 138.

sùzhì
a person's quality; upbringing
Introduced in Chapter 363.

tā
she; her
Introduced in Chapter 31.

他 *tā*
he; him
Introduced in Chapter 31.

tài
too; too much
Introduced in Chapter 41.

tái
to lift; to carry (between two people)
Introduced in Chapter 174.

太好了 *tài hǎo le*
great!; that's wonderful
Introduced in Chapter 93.

tàidu
attitude
Introduced in Chapter 398.

táifēng
typhoon
Introduced in Chapter 244.

tàiyang
sun
Introduced in Chapter 68.

太阳能 *tàiyángnéng*
solar energy; solar power
Introduced in Chapter 518.

他们 *tāmen*
they; them
Introduced in Chapter 31.

tán
to play an instrument; to pluck
Introduced in Chapter 110.

tán liàn'ài
to go out with someone; to be in a relationship
Introduced in Chapter 305.

táng
sugar; sweets
Introduced in Chapter 168.

tāng
soup
Introduced in Chapter 70.

tǎng
to lie down
Introduced in Chapter 183.

tàngshāng
to scald; to burn (with heat)
Introduced in Chapter 478.

tánhuà
to have a serious talk
Introduced in Chapter 354.

tànqì
to sigh
Introduced in Chapter 460.

tānwèi
market stall
Introduced in Chapter 448.

táo
to run away; to flee
Introduced in Chapter 301.

tǎolùn
to discuss
Introduced in Chapter 348.

tǎoyàn
to dislike; to hate
Introduced in Chapter 277.

tèbié
special; especially
Introduced in Chapter 144.

tèchǎn
a local speciality; a regional product
Introduced in Chapter 247.

特点 *tèdiǎn*
characteristic; a distinguishing trait
Introduced in Chapter 450.

tèjià
special offer; reduced price
Introduced in Chapter 193.

téng
sore; painful
Introduced in Chapter 130.

疼爱 *téng'ài*
to dote on
Introduced in Chapter 510.

téngtòng
pain; ache
Introduced in Chapter 476.

特色 *tèsè*
special character; speciality
Introduced in Chapter 451.

特意 *tèyì*
specially; for that very purpose
Introduced in Chapter 450.

tī
to kick
Introduced in Chapter 135.

tián
sweet
Introduced in Chapter 71.

天 *tiān*
day; sky
Introduced in Chapter 45.

tiānkōng
the sky
Introduced in Chapter 238.

tiānliàng
to get light at dawn
Introduced in Chapter 517.

天气 *tiānqì*
weather
Introduced in Chapter 66.

tiānqì yùbào
weather forecast
Introduced in Chapter 147.

天然 *tiānrán*
natural; made by nature
Introduced in Chapter 441.

天色 *tiānsè*
the light of the sky; how dark the sky is getting
Introduced in Chapter 452.

tiánxiě
to fill in (a form)
Introduced in Chapter 189.

天性 *tiānxìng*
one's nature; an inborn trait
Introduced in Chapter 467.

天真 *tiānzhēn*
naive; innocent
Introduced in Chapter 373.

tiào
to jump
Introduced in Chapter 107.

tiáo
measure word for long things (skirts, scarves, trousers, fish, roads)
Introduced in Chapter 165.

tiāo
to pick out; to choose
Introduced in Chapter 199.

tiàocáo
to move to another employer; to change jobs
Introduced in Chapter 489.

tiáojiàn
condition (that must be met)
Introduced in Chapter 395.

tiàoshéng
to skip with a rope
Introduced in Chapter 220.

tiàowǔ
to dance
Introduced in Chapter 110.

tiáozhěng
to adjust
Introduced in Chapter 400.

tiē
to stick; to paste up
Introduced in Chapter 334.

tígāo
to push up (a level)
Introduced in Chapter 385.

体会 *tǐhuì*
to know from experience; to come to understand
Introduced in Chapter 347.

tǐjiǎn
medical check-up
Introduced in Chapter 239.

体力 *tǐlì*
stamina; physical fitness
Introduced in Chapter 474.

tímù
title; question on a test
Introduced in Chapter 354.

tíng
to stop; to park
Introduced in Chapter 107.

tīng
to listen; to hear
Introduced in Chapter 53.

tíngchēchǎng
car park
Introduced in Chapter 192.

tíngdiàn
to have a power cut
Introduced in Chapter 167.

tīngdǒng
to understand (on hearing)
Introduced in Chapter 151.

停飞 *tíngfēi*
to be grounded (of planes)
Introduced in Chapter 418.

tíngkào
to call at a station or port
Introduced in Chapter 405.

tīngzhòng
listeners; the people listening to the radio
Introduced in Chapter 292.

tíqián
to do ahead of time; to bring forward (a date)
Introduced in Chapter 388.

tǐtiē
considerate; thoughtful of others' needs
Introduced in Chapter 468.

tíwèn
to put a question (in class or a meeting)
Introduced in Chapter 354.

tǐwēn
body temperature
Introduced in Chapter 245.

tíxǐng
to remind
Introduced in Chapter 364.

tǐyàn
to experience for yourself
Introduced in Chapter 261.

tǐyù
physical education (a school subject)
Introduced in Chapter 498.

体重 *tǐzhòng*
body weight
Introduced in Chapter 230.

tīzi
ladder
Introduced in Chapter 174.

tōngcháng
normally; usually
Introduced in Chapter 162.

通车 *tōngchē*
to open to traffic
Introduced in Chapter 409.

同感 *tónggǎn*
the same feeling
Introduced in Chapter 352.

通过 *tōngguò*
to pass through
Introduced in Chapter 410.

tónghuà
fairy tale
Introduced in Chapter 329.

tòngkuài
delighted; to one's heart's content
Introduced in Chapter 465.

tóngnián
childhood
Introduced in Chapter 269.

同情 *tóngqíng*
to sympathize with
Introduced in Chapter 460.

同事 *tóngshì*
colleague
Introduced in Chapter 255.

同时 *tóngshí*
simultaneously; at the same moment
Introduced in Chapter 372.

通往 *tōngwǎng*
to lead to
Introduced in Chapter 428.

tōngxìn
to write to each other; to correspond
Introduced in Chapter 319.

同学 *tóngxué*
classmate; schoolmate, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 15.

tóngyì
to agree
Introduced in Chapter 270.

tōngzhī
to notify; a notice
Introduced in Chapter 157.

tóu
head
Introduced in Chapter 52.

tōu
to steal
Introduced in Chapter 216.

tóubì
to drop coins in the box
Introduced in Chapter 408.

tóufa
hair (on the head)
Introduced in Chapter 124.

tóujiǎng
first prize; the jackpot
Introduced in Chapter 530.

tóusù
to make a formal complaint
Introduced in Chapter 525.

头疼 *tóuténg*
having a headache; aching in the head
Introduced in Chapter 228.

tóutiáo
lead story; headline; the front-page story
Introduced in Chapter 293.

tóuyūn
dizzy
Introduced in Chapter 480.

tù
to throw up; to vomit
Introduced in Chapter 240.

tuányuán
to be reunited as a family
Introduced in Chapter 338.

突发 *tūfā*
to break out suddenly; sudden
Introduced in Chapter 291.

tuī
to push
Introduced in Chapter 112.

tuǐ
leg
Introduced in Chapter 230.

tuìcháo
to ebb (of the tide)
Introduced in Chapter 445.

tuīchí
to put off; to postpone
Introduced in Chapter 234.

tuìfáng
to check out (of a hotel)
Introduced in Chapter 200.

tuìhuò
to take goods back; to return goods to a shop
Introduced in Chapter 202.

tuījiàn
to recommend
Introduced in Chapter 177.

tuìkuǎn
to give the money back; to refund
Introduced in Chapter 525.

tuìpiào
to return a ticket (for a refund)
Introduced in Chapter 284.

tuìxiū
to retire
Introduced in Chapter 276.

tuōdì
to mop the floor
Introduced in Chapter 142.

tuōxiǎn
to get out of danger
Introduced in Chapter 531.

tuōyùn
to check in a suitcase; to send luggage in the hold
Introduced in Chapter 415.

突然 *tūrán*
suddenly; all of a sudden
Introduced in Chapter 279.

图书 *túshū*
books on the shelves (of a library or bookshop)
Introduced in Chapter 454.

túshūguǎn
library
Introduced in Chapter 100.

tùzi
rabbit; hare
Introduced in Chapter 223.

wàibì
foreign currency
Introduced in Chapter 419.

wàibian
outside
Introduced in Chapter 85.

外地 *wàidì*
from out of town; another part of the country
Introduced in Chapter 211.

外公 *wàigōng*
grandpa on the mother's side
Introduced in Chapter 272.

wàiguó
foreign country; abroad
Introduced in Chapter 81.

外界 *wàijiè*
the outside world
Introduced in Chapter 326.

wàimài
takeaway; food delivered
Introduced in Chapter 120.

wàipó
grandma on the mother's side
Introduced in Chapter 510.

外语 *wàiyǔ*
foreign language
Introduced in Chapter 110.

wàn
ten thousand
Introduced in Chapter 132.

wán
to play; to have fun
Introduced in Chapter 56.

wān
to bend
Introduced in Chapter 475.

wǎn'ān
good night
Introduced in Chapter 76.

wánchéng
to complete; to get (a job) done
Introduced in Chapter 395.

晚点 *wǎndiǎn*
to run behind schedule; to be late (of a train or plane)
Introduced in Chapter 145.

晚饭 *wǎnfàn*
dinner; supper
Introduced in Chapter 69.

wàng
to forget
Introduced in Chapter 95.

wǎng
towards; in the direction of
Introduced in Chapter 283.

wǎnggòu
to shop online
Introduced in Chapter 387.

王国 *wángguó*
kingdom
Introduced in Chapter 330.

王后 *wánghòu*
queen (a king's wife)
Introduced in Chapter 330.

wàngjì
peak season; busy season
Introduced in Chapter 430.

wǎngqiú
tennis
Introduced in Chapter 262.

wǎngshì
past events; things of the past
Introduced in Chapter 344.

wǎngwǎng
more often than not; tends to
Introduced in Chapter 185.

wǎngyǒu
online friend
Introduced in Chapter 345.

网站 *wǎngzhàn*
website
Introduced in Chapter 204.

王子 *wángzǐ*
prince
Introduced in Chapter 330.

晚会 *wǎnhuì*
evening party; evening show
Introduced in Chapter 173.

wánjù
toy
Introduced in Chapter 269.

万能 *wànnéng*
able to do everything; all-purpose
Introduced in Chapter 393.

晚年 *wǎnnián*
one's later years; old age
Introduced in Chapter 322.

晚上 *wǎnshang*
evening
Introduced in Chapter 49.

晚上好 *wǎnshang hǎo*
good evening
Introduced in Chapter 49.

万事如意 *wànshì rúyì*
may all go as you wish
Introduced in Chapter 534.

wànyī
in case; if by any chance
Introduced in Chapter 244.

wéi
hello on the phone
Introduced in Chapter 63.

wēibōlú
microwave oven
Introduced in Chapter 170.

wèidao
taste; flavour
Introduced in Chapter 172.

wéifǎn
to break a rule; to go against the law
Introduced in Chapter 359.

wéijīn
scarf
Introduced in Chapter 165.

wèikǒu
appetite
Introduced in Chapter 477.

为了 *wèile*
for; in order to
Introduced in Chapter 235.

为难 *wéinán*
in an awkward spot; torn (about what to do)
Introduced in Chapter 397.

wěiqu
wronged; hurt by unfair blame
Introduced in Chapter 459.

wèishēng
hygiene; cleanliness
Introduced in Chapter 521.

为什么 *wèishénme*
why?
Introduced in Chapter 95.

wēixiǎn
dangerous
Introduced in Chapter 115.

wēixiào
to give a gentle smile
Introduced in Chapter 466.

wéizhāng
to break the traffic rules
Introduced in Chapter 420.

wèn
to ask
Introduced in Chapter 54.

wēndù
temperature
Introduced in Chapter 243.

温和 *wēnhé*
gentle in manner; soft-spoken
Introduced in Chapter 469.

问候 *wènhòu*
to send regards to; to greet
Introduced in Chapter 173.

wénhuà
culture
Introduced in Chapter 374.

问路 *wènlù*
to ask the way
Introduced in Chapter 197.

文明 *wénmíng*
civilization
Introduced in Chapter 326.

wèntí
question; problem
Introduced in Chapter 214.

wěnzhòng
steady; calm and reliable
Introduced in Chapter 469.

wénzi
mosquito
Introduced in Chapter 242.

文字 *wénzì*
script; written language
Introduced in Chapter 321.

我 *wǒ*
I, me — one word for both, and no change for either
Introduced in Chapter 8.

我们 *wǒmen*
we; us
Introduced in Chapter 31.

wòpù
sleeping berth
Introduced in Chapter 404.

wòshì
bedroom
Introduced in Chapter 159.

wòshǒu
to shake hands
Introduced in Chapter 336.

5 — 五 *wǔ*
the digit and the character — which one a price, a date and a phone number use
Introduced in Chapter 21.

五 *wǔ*
five
Introduced in Chapter 3.

wǔbàn
dance partner
Introduced in Chapter 505.

wǔdǎo
the art of dance
Introduced in Chapter 505.

午饭 *wǔfàn*
lunch
Introduced in Chapter 69.

wùhuì
to get the wrong idea; to misunderstand
Introduced in Chapter 367.

舞会 *wǔhuì*
dance party; ball
Introduced in Chapter 505.

wùjī
to miss a flight
Introduced in Chapter 416.

wùjià
prices; the cost of living
Introduced in Chapter 524.

午觉 *wǔjiào*
afternoon nap
Introduced in Chapter 169.

wúliáo
bored; boring
Introduced in Chapter 271.

wūrǎn
to pollute
Introduced in Chapter 380.

wǔtái
stage (in a theatre)
Introduced in Chapter 505.

wùyè
property management; the management office
Introduced in Chapter 378.

wūyún
dark clouds
Introduced in Chapter 238.

洗 *xǐ*
to wash
Introduced in Chapter 99.

xià cì
next time
Introduced in Chapter 163.

下个月 *xià ge yuè*
next month
Introduced in Chapter 148.

下星期 *xià xīngqī*
next week
Introduced in Chapter 148.

xiàbān
to finish work; to come off a shift
Introduced in Chapter 183.

xiàbian
under; below
Introduced in Chapter 86.

下车 *xiàchē*
to get off (a bus or train)
Introduced in Chapter 73.

xiàdān
to place an order
Introduced in Chapter 527.

下课 *xiàkè*
to finish class
Introduced in Chapter 79.

xián
salty
Introduced in Chapter 71.

先 *xiān*
first; before anything else
Introduced in Chapter 269.

现成 *xiànchéng*
ready-made
Introduced in Chapter 398.

现代 *xiàndài*
modern times; modern
Introduced in Chapter 323.

xiàng
to resemble; to take after
Introduced in Chapter 124.

xiāng
smelling good; fragrant; tasty
Introduced in Chapter 172.

想 *xiǎng*
to want to; to think; to miss
Introduced in Chapter 55.

xiàngcè
photo album
Introduced in Chapter 344.

想法 *xiǎngfǎ*
idea; way of thinking
Introduced in Chapter 349.

xiǎngniàn
to miss someone
Introduced in Chapter 325.

想起 *xiǎngqǐ*
to think of; to call to mind
Introduced in Chapter 324.

xiǎngshòu
to enjoy
Introduced in Chapter 277.

xiàngwǎng
to yearn for
Introduced in Chapter 533.

xiāngxìn
to believe; to trust
Introduced in Chapter 270.

想要 *xiǎngyào*
to want; would like
Introduced in Chapter 91.

xiāngzi
box; suitcase; trunk
Introduced in Chapter 119.

xiànjīn
cash
Introduced in Chapter 114.

xiànmù
to envy
Introduced in Chapter 460.

xiānnǚ
fairy; heavenly maiden
Introduced in Chapter 329.

xiànr
filling
Introduced in Chapter 341.

xiānsheng
Mr; sir; husband
Introduced in Chapter 35.

xiànxuè
to give blood
Introduced in Chapter 479.

xiànzài
now
Introduced in Chapter 45.

xiànzhì
to put a limit on; to restrict
Introduced in Chapter 359.

xiánzhì
unused; lying idle
Introduced in Chapter 386.

xiào
to laugh; to smile
Introduced in Chapter 56.

小 *xiǎo*
small; little, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 14.

小吃 *xiǎochī*
snack; street food
Introduced in Chapter 182.

xiāodú
to disinfect
Introduced in Chapter 482.

xiāofángyuán
firefighter
Introduced in Chapter 298.

xiǎofèi
tip; a tip for the waiter
Introduced in Chapter 452.

xiàoguǒ
the effect it has (how well it works)
Introduced in Chapter 537.

小孩 *xiǎohái*
child; kid
Introduced in Chapter 253.

xiāohuà
to digest
Introduced in Chapter 452.

笑话 *xiàohua*
joke
Introduced in Chapter 267.

小名 *xiǎomíng*
childhood pet name
Introduced in Chapter 303.

小气 *xiǎoqì*
stingy; mean (with money)
Introduced in Chapter 265.

小区 *xiǎoqū*
housing estate; residential compound
Introduced in Chapter 377.

xiǎoshēng
in a low voice; quietly
Introduced in Chapter 363.

xiāoshī
to disappear; to vanish
Introduced in Chapter 329.

小时 *xiǎoshí*
hour
Introduced in Chapter 97.

xiǎoshíhou
in childhood; when one was little
Introduced in Chapter 78.

小说 *xiǎoshuō*
novel; story (in a book)
Introduced in Chapter 250.

xiǎotíqín
violin
Introduced in Chapter 506.

小偷 *xiǎotōu*
thief
Introduced in Chapter 309.

xiāoxi
news; a message
Introduced in Chapter 157.

小心 *xiǎoxīn*
to be careful; to mind (something)
Introduced in Chapter 115.

小心眼 *xiǎoxīnyǎn*
petty; narrow-minded
Introduced in Chapter 471.

小学 *xiǎoxué*
primary school, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 14.

小学生 *xiǎoxuésheng*
primary-school student, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 14.

校长 *xiàozhǎng*
head teacher; principal
Introduced in Chapter 248.

xiàqí
to play chess
Introduced in Chapter 250.

xiàrén
scary; giving people a fright
Introduced in Chapter 463.

下山 *xiàshān*
to come down a mountain
Introduced in Chapter 435.

xiàshǔ
subordinate; someone under one at work
Introduced in Chapter 491.

xiàtiān
summer
Introduced in Chapter 131.

xiàwǔ
afternoon
Introduced in Chapter 49.

下午茶 *xiàwǔchá*
afternoon tea (a light meal)
Introduced in Chapter 166.

xiàyǔ
to rain
Introduced in Chapter 66.

xiàzài
to download
Introduced in Chapter 109.

西北 *xīběi*
northwest; the Northwest (of China)
Introduced in Chapter 422.

xībian
the west; on the west side
Introduced in Chapter 117.

西部 *xībù*
western part; the western regions
Introduced in Chapter 438.

xié
shoe
Introduced in Chapter 59.

xiě
to write
Introduced in Chapter 54.

血 *xiě*
blood
Introduced in Chapter 479.

xièjué
to decline politely
Introduced in Chapter 355.

谢谢 *xièxie*
thank you — the same character twice, and the second one goes light
Introduced in Chapter 10.

写作 *xiězuò*
to write essays and stories; writing
Introduced in Chapter 251.

xīgài
knee
Introduced in Chapter 475.

xīguā
watermelon
Introduced in Chapter 237.

xíguàn
to be used to; a habit
Introduced in Chapter 158.

喜欢 *xǐhuan*
xǐhuan — 'to like', an ordinary verb with an ordinary object, and no inversion anywhere
Introduced in Chapter 28.

xǐliǎn
to wash one's face
Introduced in Chapter 99.

xìn
letter (in the post)
Introduced in Chapter 118.

xīn
new
Introduced in Chapter 61.

心爱 *xīn'ài*
beloved; treasured
Introduced in Chapter 461.

西南 *xīnán*
southwest; the Southwest (of China)
Introduced in Chapter 423.

xìnfēng
envelope
Introduced in Chapter 318.

xìng
to have the family name; family name
Introduced in Chapter 34.

xǐng
to wake up
Introduced in Chapter 146.

xíngchéng
itinerary; plan for a trip
Introduced in Chapter 428.

xīngfèn
thrilled; keyed up
Introduced in Chapter 458.

xìnggé
personality; character
Introduced in Chapter 258.

星光 *xīngguāng*
starlight
Introduced in Chapter 517.

xìnghǎo
luckily; fortunately
Introduced in Chapter 236.

xīngjí
hotel star rating
Introduced in Chapter 426.

xíngli
luggage
Introduced in Chapter 119.

xínglijià
luggage rack
Introduced in Chapter 406.

xínglixiāng
luggage case; a travel case
Introduced in Chapter 453.

xìngmíng
full name
Introduced in Chapter 455.

星期 *xīngqī*
week
Introduced in Chapter 46.

星期天 *xīngqītiān*
Sunday
Introduced in Chapter 46.

星期一 *xīngqīyī*
Monday
Introduced in Chapter 46.

xìngqù
interest; interest in something
Introduced in Chapter 250.

星星 *xīngxing*
star
Introduced in Chapter 68.

xìngyùn
lucky; fortunate
Introduced in Chapter 529.

xìnhào
phone signal
Introduced in Chapter 198.

xīnkǔ
exhausting; toilsome (of work)
Introduced in Chapter 490.

xīnláng
bridegroom
Introduced in Chapter 305.

心理 *xīnlǐ*
state of mind; psychology
Introduced in Chapter 351.

心里话 *xīnlǐhuà*
what is really on one's mind; words from the heart
Introduced in Chapter 459.

xīnniáng
bride
Introduced in Chapter 306.

xīnqíng
mood; frame of mind
Introduced in Chapter 245.

新人 *xīnrén*
the bride and groom
Introduced in Chapter 306.

xīnshǎng
to admire; to appreciate
Introduced in Chapter 277.

新生 *xīnshēng*
new student
Introduced in Chapter 303.

心事 *xīnshì*
something on your mind; a worry
Introduced in Chapter 271.

新手 *xīnshǒu*
novice; beginner
Introduced in Chapter 296.

xīntài
mindset; attitude of mind
Introduced in Chapter 485.

心疼 *xīnténg*
to feel for someone; to love dearly
Introduced in Chapter 458.

xīntiào
heartbeat
Introduced in Chapter 466.

xīnwén
the news; news on TV and radio
Introduced in Chapter 290.

xīnxiān
fresh
Introduced in Chapter 177.

心想事成 *xīnxiǎng shìchéng*
may your wishes all come true
Introduced in Chapter 533.

信心 *xìnxīn*
confidence; faith
Introduced in Chapter 319.

心意 *xīnyì*
kind thoughts; a token of regard
Introduced in Chapter 337.

xìnyòngkǎ
credit card
Introduced in Chapter 195.

xīnzàng
the heart as an organ
Introduced in Chapter 477.

心中 *xīnzhōng*
in one's heart
Introduced in Chapter 343.

xiōngdì
brothers
Introduced in Chapter 507.

xióngmāo
a panda; giant panda
Introduced in Chapter 223.

xiōngmèi
elder brother and younger sister
Introduced in Chapter 508.

喜庆 *xǐqìng*
festive; joyous
Introduced in Chapter 339.

喜事 *xǐshì*
a happy occasion; a wedding in the family
Introduced in Chapter 305.

xǐshǒujiān
toilet; washroom
Introduced in Chapter 86.

xǐtáng
wedding sweets
Introduced in Chapter 306.

xǐtóu
to wash one's hair
Introduced in Chapter 164.

xiū
to repair; to fix
Introduced in Chapter 103.

xiūgǎi
to revise; to correct (a piece of work)
Introduced in Chapter 251.

xiūxi
to rest
Introduced in Chapter 50.

xǐwǎn
to do the washing-up; to wash the dishes
Introduced in Chapter 160.

希望 *xīwàng*
to hope
Introduced in Chapter 533.

xìxīn
careful; attentive to detail
Introduced in Chapter 273.

xīyān
to smoke
Introduced in Chapter 115.

西医 *xīyī*
western medicine; a doctor of it
Introduced in Chapter 231.

洗衣店 *xǐyīdiàn*
laundry shop
Introduced in Chapter 215.

xǐyīfěn
washing powder
Introduced in Chapter 179.

洗衣机 *xǐyījī*
washing machine
Introduced in Chapter 179.

xǐzǎo
to have a shower; to have a bath
Introduced in Chapter 99.

xuǎn
to choose
Introduced in Chapter 210.

xuānbù
to announce officially
Introduced in Chapter 291.

xuānchuáncè
brochure; leaflet
Introduced in Chapter 454.

xuǎnzé
to make a choice
Introduced in Chapter 368.

xuě
snow
Introduced in Chapter 66.

学 *xué*
study; learn, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 13.

xuéfèi
tuition fees
Introduced in Chapter 304.

雪花 *xuěhuā*
snowflake
Introduced in Chapter 243.

学会 *xuéhuì*
to learn (and now be able to)
Introduced in Chapter 151.

xuějǐng
a snowy landscape
Introduced in Chapter 519.

学期 *xuéqī*
school term; semester
Introduced in Chapter 248.

学区房 *xuéqūfáng*
a home near a good school
Introduced in Chapter 377.

雪人 *xuěrén*
snowman
Introduced in Chapter 221.

学生 *xuésheng*
student, now read and written
Introduced in Chapter 13.

xuéxí
to study; to learn
Introduced in Chapter 54.

xuéxiào
school
Introduced in Chapter 43.

xuèyā
blood pressure
Introduced in Chapter 479.

xùnliàn
to do training (for a sport); to drill
Introduced in Chapter 499.

xúnluó
to patrol
Introduced in Chapter 382.

xǔnuò
to give one's word; to pledge
Introduced in Chapter 534.

xūyào
to need
Introduced in Chapter 91.

xǔyuàn
to make a wish
Introduced in Chapter 337.

yáchǐ
tooth; teeth
Introduced in Chapter 473.

yágāo
toothpaste
Introduced in Chapter 105.

yājīn
a deposit paid in advance
Introduced in Chapter 203.

yālì
pressure; stress
Introduced in Chapter 485.

yáncháng
to extend (in time)
Introduced in Chapter 400.

yǎnchàng
to perform a song (on stage)
Introduced in Chapter 504.

yǎnchū
to perform on stage
Introduced in Chapter 257.

yǎng
to keep an animal; to raise
Introduced in Chapter 229.

yǎngchéng
to form (a habit); to get into a habit
Introduced in Chapter 484.

阳光 *yángguāng*
sunshine
Introduced in Chapter 518.

yángtái
balcony
Introduced in Chapter 159.

yàngzi
appearance; manner
Introduced in Chapter 233.

yānhuā
fireworks
Introduced in Chapter 339.

yǎnjing
eye
Introduced in Chapter 52.

yǎnjìng
glasses; spectacles
Introduced in Chapter 233.

yǎnlèi
tears
Introduced in Chapter 471.

眼前 *yǎnqián*
before one's eyes; right now
Introduced in Chapter 471.

yánsè
colour
Introduced in Chapter 60.

yánwù
to be delayed; to be held up
Introduced in Chapter 416.

yǎnyuán
actor; performer
Introduced in Chapter 267.

yánzhòng
serious (of illness); serious (of a problem)
Introduced in Chapter 228.

yǎnzòu
to perform on an instrument
Introduced in Chapter 506.

yào
to want; to ask for
Introduced in Chapter 41.

要不是 *yàobúshì*
if it were not for
Introduced in Chapter 541.

yàodiàn
chemist's; pharmacy
Introduced in Chapter 190.

yāoguài
monster; demon
Introduced in Chapter 331.

要价 *yàojià*
to name one's price; to ask a price
Introduced in Chapter 524.

要紧 *yàojǐn*
urgent; a cause for concern
Introduced in Chapter 481.

yáokòngqì
remote control
Introduced in Chapter 171.

要么 *yàome*
either one or the other; either … or
Introduced in Chapter 541.

yàopiàn
tablet; pill
Introduced in Chapter 482.

yāoqǐng
to invite; an invitation
Introduced in Chapter 173.

yāoqiú
to require; to demand (of someone)
Introduced in Chapter 399.

yàoshi
key
Introduced in Chapter 87.

要是 *yàoshi*
if
Introduced in Chapter 288.

yáotóu
to shake one's head
Introduced in Chapter 476.

yáshuā
toothbrush
Introduced in Chapter 105.

牙医 *yáyī*
dentist
Introduced in Chapter 473.

yāzi
duck
Introduced in Chapter 439.

也 *yě*
also; too
Introduced in Chapter 92.

yèbān
night shift
Introduced in Chapter 490.

yěcān
to have a picnic; a picnic
Introduced in Chapter 163.

yèli
at night
Introduced in Chapter 146.

yèshì
night market
Introduced in Chapter 449.

yěwài
the open country; the wild
Introduced in Chapter 441.

yěxǔ
it may be that; perhaps
Introduced in Chapter 256.

yéye
grandpa on the father's side
Introduced in Chapter 253.

yèzi
leaf
Introduced in Chapter 237.

一 *yī*
one
Introduced in Chapter 3.

一百 *yìbǎi*
a hundred — and the one word in the run whose tone moves
Introduced in Chapter 21.

yìbān
generally; as a rule; ordinary
Introduced in Chapter 162.

一半 *yíbàn*
one half; half (of something)
Introduced in Chapter 140.

一边 *yìbiān*
at the same time (said twice, before two verbs); one side
Introduced in Chapter 149.

yícìxìng
disposable; used once
Introduced in Chapter 383.

一大早 *yídàzǎo*
first thing in the morning; at the crack of dawn
Introduced in Chapter 169.

一点儿 *yìdiǎnr*
a little; a bit
Introduced in Chapter 91.

yídìng
certainly; definitely
Introduced in Chapter 147.

yǐfáng
so as to guard against; as a precaution
Introduced in Chapter 389.

yīfu
clothes
Introduced in Chapter 58.

yígòng
altogether; in all
Introduced in Chapter 132.

yīguì
wardrobe
Introduced in Chapter 179.

yíhàn
a pity; regrettable
Introduced in Chapter 286.

yǐhòu
after; afterwards
Introduced in Chapter 97.

一会儿 *yíhuìr*
a little while; in a moment
Introduced in Chapter 76.

意见 *yìjiàn*
a suggestion; an objection
Introduced in Chapter 280.

yǐjīng
already
Introduced in Chapter 126.

yíkuàir
all together; together (in everyday speech)
Introduced in Chapter 163.

yílù píng'ān
have a safe journey
Introduced in Chapter 213.

yímín
to emigrate; to settle abroad
Introduced in Chapter 437.

yīncǐ
for this reason; and so (written or careful speech)
Introduced in Chapter 281.

yìng
hard; stiff
Introduced in Chapter 134.

yīng'ér
newborn; infant
Introduced in Chapter 302.

应该 *yīnggāi*
should; ought to
Introduced in Chapter 282.

Yīngguó
Britain; the United Kingdom
Introduced in Chapter 36.

yìngpìn
to apply for a job
Introduced in Chapter 486.

yǐngxiǎng
to affect; influence; to have an effect on
Introduced in Chapter 294.

yīngxióng
hero
Introduced in Chapter 327.

yíngyǎng
nutrition; nourishment
Introduced in Chapter 483.

yíngyè
to be open for business
Introduced in Chapter 122.

Yīngyǔ
English (the language)
Introduced in Chapter 492.

yìngzuò
hard seat
Introduced in Chapter 404.

yínháng
bank
Introduced in Chapter 100.

yǐnliào
drink; soft drink
Introduced in Chapter 102.

yǐnqǐ
to give rise to; to bring about
Introduced in Chapter 294.

yīnsù
factor
Introduced in Chapter 370.

yīntiān
overcast day
Introduced in Chapter 136.

因为 *yīnwèi*
because
Introduced in Chapter 96.

yìnxiàng
impression
Introduced in Chapter 324.

音乐 *yīnyuè*
music
Introduced in Chapter 128.

音乐会 *yīnyuèhuì*
concert
Introduced in Chapter 128.

一起 *yìqǐ*
together
Introduced in Chapter 84.

以前 *yǐqián*
before; in the past
Introduced in Chapter 126.

yíqiè
everything; all
Introduced in Chapter 401.

yīshēng
doctor
Introduced in Chapter 80.

一生 *yìshēng*
all one's life; a lifetime
Introduced in Chapter 322.

yìshù
art; the arts
Introduced in Chapter 503.

意思 *yìsi*
meaning; what something means
Introduced in Chapter 347.

意外 *yìwài*
mishap; something unexpected
Introduced in Chapter 296.

以为 *yǐwéi*
to wrongly assume; to take it that (often wrongly)
Introduced in Chapter 346.

yìwù
duty; obligation
Introduced in Chapter 362.

意想不到 *yìxiǎngbúdào*
unexpected; beyond what anyone imagined
Introduced in Chapter 462.

一下子 *yíxiàzi*
all at once; in no time
Introduced in Chapter 279.

一些 *yìxiē*
some; a few
Introduced in Chapter 127.

yíyàng
the same; alike
Introduced in Chapter 94.

yìyì
significance; meaning
Introduced in Chapter 347.

yīyuàn
hospital
Introduced in Chapter 44.

yìzhí
straight on; all the way
Introduced in Chapter 197.

yízhì
all of one mind; in agreement
Introduced in Chapter 348.

yǐzi
chair
Introduced in Chapter 57.

用 *yòng*
to use
Introduced in Chapter 103.

yǒnggǎn
brave
Introduced in Chapter 265.

yōngjǐ
crowded
Introduced in Chapter 406.

用力 *yònglì*
to push hard; to put one's strength into it
Introduced in Chapter 474.

用心 *yòngxīn*
attentive; putting your heart into it
Introduced in Chapter 273.

用意 *yòngyì*
intention; the purpose behind it
Introduced in Chapter 372.

yǒngyuǎn
forever
Introduced in Chapter 344.

又 *yòu*
yet again; it happened again
Introduced in Chapter 315.

有 *yǒu*
yǒu — 'to have', and also 'there is': one verb where Spanish spends three points
Introduced in Chapter 24.

yòu'éryuán
kindergarten; nursery school
Introduced in Chapter 303.

yòubian
the right; on the right
Introduced in Chapter 82.

yóubiān
postcode
Introduced in Chapter 345.

游船 *yóuchuán*
pleasure boat
Introduced in Chapter 431.

yōudiǎn
strong point; merit
Introduced in Chapter 372.

有点儿 *yǒudiǎnr*
a bit (of something unwanted); rather
Introduced in Chapter 93.

yǒuhǎo
friendly
Introduced in Chapter 258.

yóuhuà
oil painting
Introduced in Chapter 502.

yōuhuì
a favourable deal (for customers)
Introduced in Chapter 527.

游记 *yóujì*
travel notes; account of a journey
Introduced in Chapter 434.

yóujiàn
email; mail
Introduced in Chapter 201.

yóujú
post office
Introduced in Chapter 100.

yóukè
tourist
Introduced in Chapter 213.

yǒukòng
to have free time; to be free
Introduced in Chapter 163.

有理 *yǒulǐ*
reasonable; in the right
Introduced in Chapter 351.

yōumò
humorous; witty (of a person)
Introduced in Chapter 258.

yóunì
greasy; oily
Introduced in Chapter 449.

yóupiào
postage stamp
Introduced in Chapter 201.

有钱 *yǒuqián*
rich; well-off
Introduced in Chapter 188.

yǒuqù
fun; amusing
Introduced in Chapter 277.

yǒushì
to have something on; to be busy
Introduced in Chapter 95.

yǒushíhou
sometimes
Introduced in Chapter 126.

有望 *yǒuwàng*
with good hopes of it; likely to happen
Introduced in Chapter 532.

yóuxì
game
Introduced in Chapter 141.

yǒuxiào
valid; effective
Introduced in Chapter 455.

yǒuyìsi
interesting
Introduced in Chapter 129.

yóuyǒng
to swim
Introduced in Chapter 90.

yóuyú
owing to; because of
Introduced in Chapter 235.

yú
fish
Introduced in Chapter 67.

雨 *yǔ*
rain
Introduced in Chapter 66.

yuán
round
Introduced in Chapter 139.

yuǎn
far
Introduced in Chapter 62.

元 *yuán*
yuan (the unit of money, as written; said kuài)
Introduced in Chapter 156.

yuándìng
originally planned
Introduced in Chapter 400.

原来 *yuánlái*
so (it turns out); as it turns out
Introduced in Chapter 537.

yuánliàng
to forgive
Introduced in Chapter 275.

yuánmèng
to fulfil a dream
Introduced in Chapter 536.

愿望 *yuànwàng*
a wish one has; a desire
Introduced in Chapter 535.

Yuánxiāo
the Lantern Festival
Introduced in Chapter 335.

愿意 *yuànyì*
to be willing (to)
Introduced in Chapter 535.

yuányīn
reason; cause
Introduced in Chapter 145.

yuánzé
principle
Introduced in Chapter 371.

yúchuán
fishing boat
Introduced in Chapter 445.

yùdào
to run into; to come across
Introduced in Chapter 227.

yùdìng
to book ahead
Introduced in Chapter 200.

yuè
month; moon
Introduced in Chapter 47.

yuē
to arrange to meet; to make a date with
Introduced in Chapter 180.

月饼 *yuèbǐng*
mooncake
Introduced in Chapter 341.

约定 *yuēdìng*
to agree on a time; to fix (a time or place) together
Introduced in Chapter 390.

yuèduì
band (of musicians)
Introduced in Chapter 506.

yuèguāng
moonlight
Introduced in Chapter 343.

约会 *yuēhuì*
a romantic date; an appointment (to meet)
Introduced in Chapter 388.

yuèliang
the moon
Introduced in Chapter 238.

yuèqì
musical instrument
Introduced in Chapter 257.

yùfáng
to prevent; to guard against
Introduced in Chapter 484.

雨季 *yǔjì*
rainy season
Introduced in Chapter 515.

yúkuài
pleasant; cheerful
Introduced in Chapter 247.

yùmèn
down; gloomy
Introduced in Chapter 460.

yùn
to iron
Introduced in Chapter 179.

云 *yún*
cloud
Introduced in Chapter 219.

yùnchuán
to get seasick
Introduced in Chapter 227.

yūndǎo
to faint; to pass out
Introduced in Chapter 299.

yùndòng
sport; exercise
Introduced in Chapter 56.

yùndòngyuán
athlete
Introduced in Chapter 501.

yùnjī
to get airsick
Introduced in Chapter 414.

运气 *yùnqi*
a person's luck (good or bad)
Introduced in Chapter 529.

yǔnxǔ
to allow; to permit
Introduced in Chapter 209.

yǔsǎn
umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 116.

yùshì
bathroom
Introduced in Chapter 181.

yúshì
so; and then (as a result)
Introduced in Chapter 294.

yùsuàn
budget
Introduced in Chapter 387.

语文 *yǔwén*
Chinese (as a school subject)
Introduced in Chapter 492.

yùxí
to prepare a lesson (before class)
Introduced in Chapter 249.

雨衣 *yǔyī*
raincoat
Introduced in Chapter 234.

语音 *yǔyīn*
voice message; speech sounds
Introduced in Chapter 320.

yùyuē
to make an appointment; to book
Introduced in Chapter 212.

再 *zài*
again (still to come); once more
Introduced in Chapter 283.

在 *zài*
to be at; in, at
Introduced in Chapter 85.

zàihūn
to remarry
Introduced in Chapter 307.

再见 *zàijiàn*
goodbye — two characters whose meanings genuinely add up
Introduced in Chapter 6.

再说 *zàishuō*
to leave it till later
Introduced in Chapter 76.

zànchéng
to approve of; to be in favour
Introduced in Chapter 270.

zāng
dirty
Introduced in Chapter 93.

zànglǐ
funeral
Introduced in Chapter 314.

早 *zǎo*
early
Introduced in Chapter 83.

zàochéng
to cause damage or trouble
Introduced in Chapter 537.

早饭 *zǎofàn*
breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 69.

zāogāo
oh no; what a mess
Introduced in Chapter 216.

早年 *zǎonián*
one's early years; long ago
Introduced in Chapter 322.

早上 *zǎoshang*
morning — and a syllable with no tone at all
Introduced in Chapter 7.

早上好 *zǎoshang hǎo*
good morning — and proof that 好 was a building block
Introduced in Chapter 7.

早市 *zǎoshì*
morning market; a market held at dawn
Introduced in Chapter 448.

早晚 *zǎowǎn*
morning and evening; sooner or later
Introduced in Chapter 185.

zàoyīn
unwanted noise; din
Introduced in Chapter 378.

zázhì
magazine
Introduced in Chapter 293.

zēngjiā
to increase
Introduced in Chapter 384.

怎么 *zěnme*
how; in what way
Introduced in Chapter 283.

zěnme bàn
what should I do?
Introduced in Chapter 214.

怎么回事 *zěnme huí shì*
what is going on here; what's the matter
Introduced in Chapter 540.

zěnmeyàng
zěnmeyàng — 'how is it?', the everyday way to ask how somebody is doing
Introduced in Chapter 30.

zérèn
responsibility; blame
Introduced in Chapter 297.

zhá
to deep-fry
Introduced in Chapter 168.

zhāi
to pick fruit; to pick flowers
Introduced in Chapter 225.

zhàn
to stand
Introduced in Chapter 89.

zhāng
(a measure word for flat things: tables, beds, tickets)
Introduced in Chapter 88.

zhǎngbèi
one's elders; the older generation
Introduced in Chapter 507.

长大 *zhǎngdà*
to grow up
Introduced in Chapter 78.

zhàngdān
bill (to pay)
Introduced in Chapter 387.

zhànghù
bank account
Introduced in Chapter 195.

zhǎngjià
to get dearer; to go up in price
Introduced in Chapter 193.

zhàngpeng
tent
Introduced in Chapter 441.

zhǎngshuǐ
to rise after rain (of a river)
Introduced in Chapter 442.

zhànpái
bus stop sign
Introduced in Chapter 408.

zhàntái
a platform (at a station)
Introduced in Chapter 284.

zhànxiàn
engaged; busy (of a phone line)
Introduced in Chapter 198.

站长 *zhànzhǎng*
stationmaster; head of a station
Introduced in Chapter 403.

zhànzhēng
war
Introduced in Chapter 327.

zhǎo
to look for
Introduced in Chapter 63.

zhāodài
to look after your guests; to entertain
Introduced in Chapter 361.

找到 *zhǎodào*
to find
Introduced in Chapter 197.

zhàogù
to look after; to take care of
Introduced in Chapter 160.

找回 *zhǎohuí*
to get back (something lost)
Introduced in Chapter 285.

zháohuǒ
to catch fire
Introduced in Chapter 176.

zháojí
anxious; in a hurry
Introduced in Chapter 125.

zháoliáng
to catch a chill
Introduced in Chapter 222.

zhāopáicài
a restaurant's signature dish
Introduced in Chapter 450.

zhàopiàn
photo; photograph
Introduced in Chapter 109.

zhāopìn
to recruit; to advertise a job
Introduced in Chapter 486.

zhǎoqián
to give change
Introduced in Chapter 114.

zhàoxiàng
to take a photo
Introduced in Chapter 207.

zhǎyǎn
to blink; to wink
Introduced in Chapter 471.

这 *zhè*
this
Introduced in Chapter 37.

这个 *zhège*
this one
Introduced in Chapter 37.

这么 *zhème*
so; this much; like this
Introduced in Chapter 280.

zhēn
really; truly
Introduced in Chapter 77.

zhēng
to steam (food)
Introduced in Chapter 168.

正常 *zhèngcháng*
normal; as usual
Introduced in Chapter 178.

正点 *zhèngdiǎn*
on schedule (of a train or plane)
Introduced in Chapter 403.

zhèngfǔ
government
Introduced in Chapter 374.

正好 *zhènghǎo*
exactly right; as it happens
Introduced in Chapter 149.

zhèngjiàn
papers; an identity document
Introduced in Chapter 285.

正经 *zhèngjīng*
decent; serious and proper
Introduced in Chapter 469.

zhèngjù
evidence; proof
Introduced in Chapter 310.

zhěnglǐ
to sort out; to put in order
Introduced in Chapter 142.

zhēnglùn
to argue over a point; to debate
Introduced in Chapter 348.

zhèngmíng
to prove
Introduced in Chapter 350.

zhěngqí
neat; orderly
Introduced in Chapter 521.

zhēngqǔ
to strive for; to fight for
Introduced in Chapter 513.

zhèngrén
witness
Introduced in Chapter 310.

正月 *zhēngyuè*
first lunar month
Introduced in Chapter 334.

正在 *zhèngzài*
in the middle of (doing)
Introduced in Chapter 149.

zhèngzōng
authentic; the real thing (of food)
Introduced in Chapter 450.

zhěntou
pillow
Introduced in Chapter 181.

真心 *zhēnxīn*
sincere; from the bottom of your heart
Introduced in Chapter 358.

zhènyǔ
a rain shower
Introduced in Chapter 244.

真正 *zhēnzhèng*
real; genuine
Introduced in Chapter 358.

这儿 *zhèr*
here
Introduced in Chapter 57.

这些 *zhèxiē*
these
Introduced in Chapter 127.

zhèyàng
like this; this way
Introduced in Chapter 127.

zhī
(a measure word for animals, and for one of a pair)
Introduced in Chapter 88.

zhǐ
paper
Introduced in Chapter 104.

zhì'ān
law and order; public order
Introduced in Chapter 379.

zhíbān
to be on duty
Introduced in Chapter 382.

zhíbō
to broadcast live; a live show
Introduced in Chapter 292.

职场 *zhíchǎng*
the workplace; the world of work
Introduced in Chapter 491.

zhīchí
to support; to back
Introduced in Chapter 270.

zhídá
to go direct; to go without changing
Introduced in Chapter 405.

zhīdào
to know a fact; to be aware
Introduced in Chapter 62.

zhíde
to be worth it; to be worth doing
Introduced in Chapter 366.

职工 *zhígōng*
member of staff; employee (of a firm or factory)
Introduced in Chapter 489.

zhǐhǎo
to have no choice but to
Introduced in Chapter 235.

zhīhòu
after (a time); after (an event)
Introduced in Chapter 185.

zhíjī
to check in for a flight
Introduced in Chapter 418.

zhìliàng
quality
Introduced in Chapter 193.

zhìliáo
to give medical treatment; to cure
Introduced in Chapter 482.

zhǐlù
to give directions; to show someone the way
Introduced in Chapter 454.

zhīqián
before (a time); before (an event)
Introduced in Chapter 185.

zhìshǎo
at least
Introduced in Chapter 368.

zhīshi
knowledge
Introduced in Chapter 497.

zhǐwàng
to count on someone
Introduced in Chapter 532.

zhíwèi
a position in a firm
Introduced in Chapter 489.

zhíwù
plant
Introduced in Chapter 237.

zhìxiàng
ambition in life; the goal one sets oneself
Introduced in Chapter 512.

zhǐxuè
to stop the bleeding
Introduced in Chapter 479.

只要 *zhǐyào*
as long as; provided (that)
Introduced in Chapter 399.

zhíyè
occupation; profession
Introduced in Chapter 259.

只有 *zhǐyǒu*
only if (with cái after it)
Introduced in Chapter 399.

zhìyuànzhě
volunteer
Introduced in Chapter 375.

zhǒng
swollen
Introduced in Chapter 240.

重 *zhòng*
heavy
Introduced in Chapter 134.

zhòngdì
to farm; to work the land
Introduced in Chapter 225.

zhōngdiǎnzhàn
terminus; the end of the line
Introduced in Chapter 407.

zhōnggào
word of advice; warning
Introduced in Chapter 365.

中国 *zhōngguó*
China
Introduced in Chapter 17.

中国人 *Zhōngguó rén*
中国人 — a Chinese person, built out of three characters you already write
Introduced in Chapter 22.

中级 *zhōngjí*
intermediate (in level)
Introduced in Chapter 496.

zhōngjiān
the middle; between
Introduced in Chapter 82.

zhòngjiǎng
to win in a draw; to win a prize
Introduced in Chapter 530.

重量 *zhòngliàng*
weight; how heavy something is
Introduced in Chapter 526.

中年 *zhōngnián*
middle age
Introduced in Chapter 266.

中秋 *Zhōngqiū*
the Mid-Autumn Festival
Introduced in Chapter 342.

重伤 *zhòngshāng*
serious injury; badly hurt
Introduced in Chapter 478.

zhòngshì
to attach importance to
Introduced in Chapter 385.

zhòngshù
to plant trees
Introduced in Chapter 384.

中文 *zhōngwén*
Chinese; the Chinese language
Introduced in Chapter 17.

中午 *zhōngwǔ*
noon
Introduced in Chapter 49.

中学 *zhōngxué*
middle school, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 15.

中学生 *zhōngxuésheng*
middle-school student, built from known characters
Introduced in Chapter 15.

重要 *zhòngyào*
important
Introduced in Chapter 144.

中医 *zhōngyī*
traditional Chinese medicine; a doctor of it
Introduced in Chapter 231.

zhōngyú
at long last
Introduced in Chapter 294.

zhōudào
attentive and thorough (of service)
Introduced in Chapter 525.

zhōumò
weekend
Introduced in Chapter 46.

zhōuwéi
surroundings; the area around
Introduced in Chapter 377.

zhù
to live somewhere; to stay
Introduced in Chapter 35.

zhū
pig
Introduced in Chapter 242.

zhǔ
to boil; to cook in water
Introduced in Chapter 113.

祝 *zhù*
to wish someone well
Introduced in Chapter 337.

zhuā
to scratch; to grab
Introduced in Chapter 229.

zhuàn
to earn money; to make a profit
Introduced in Chapter 488.

zhuàng
to crash into; to bump into
Introduced in Chapter 232.

zhuǎngào
to pass on a message
Introduced in Chapter 318.

zhuàngguān
magnificent; spectacular
Introduced in Chapter 435.

zhuāngxiū
to do up a home; to renovate
Introduced in Chapter 313.

zhuǎnjī
to change planes
Introduced in Chapter 416.

zhuānyè
major; field of study
Introduced in Chapter 492.

zhǔchírén
presenter; host of a show
Introduced in Chapter 290.

zhùfú
blessing; good wishes
Introduced in Chapter 343.

zhǔfu
to exhort; to tell (someone) to be sure to do something
Introduced in Chapter 393.

zhuī
to chase; to run after
Introduced in Chapter 311.

zhuīqiú
to pursue (a goal); to chase a dream
Introduced in Chapter 512.

zhǔnbèi
to get ready; to prepare
Introduced in Chapter 84.

zhǔnshí
on time; punctual
Introduced in Chapter 143.

zhuōzi
table
Introduced in Chapter 57.

zhǔrén
host; owner
Introduced in Chapter 180.

zhùsù
accommodation; a place to stay
Introduced in Chapter 425.

zhǔyào
main; chief
Introduced in Chapter 541.

zhùyì
to pay attention; to take care
Introduced in Chapter 115.

zhǔyi
bright idea; idea of what to do
Introduced in Chapter 347.

zhùyuàn
to be in hospital
Introduced in Chapter 241.

zhǔzhāng
to argue in favour of; to advocate
Introduced in Chapter 349.

字 *zì*
a written Chinese character, recovered without pinyin
Introduced in Chapter 16.

自从 *zìcóng*
since; ever since
Introduced in Chapter 308.

zìjǐ
oneself
Introduced in Chapter 138.

子女 *zǐnǚ*
sons and daughters; children
Introduced in Chapter 253.

zìpāi
to take a selfie
Introduced in Chapter 430.

自然 *zìrán*
naturally; nature
Introduced in Chapter 316.

zǐsè
purple
Introduced in Chapter 210.

zìsī
selfish
Introduced in Chapter 470.

自信 *zìxìn*
self-confident; sure of oneself
Introduced in Chapter 465.

zìxíngchē
bicycle
Introduced in Chapter 106.

自学 *zìxué*
to teach oneself
Introduced in Chapter 497.

zīxún
to make an inquiry; to ask for advice
Introduced in Chapter 454.

zīyuán
natural resources
Introduced in Chapter 384.

自愿 *zìyuàn*
of one's own free will; voluntary
Introduced in Chapter 535.

自在 *zìzai*
at ease; free and relaxed
Introduced in Chapter 315.

zìzhùcān
buffet
Introduced in Chapter 427.

zǒngjié
to sum up
Introduced in Chapter 371.

zōngsè
brown
Introduced in Chapter 210.

zǒngshì
every single time; always
Introduced in Chapter 162.

zǒngzhī
in short; in a word
Introduced in Chapter 370.

zǒu
to walk; to leave
Introduced in Chapter 43.

zǒulù
to walk; to go on foot
Introduced in Chapter 194.

zǒusàn
to get separated (in a crowd)
Introduced in Chapter 456.

走运 *zǒuyùn*
to be in luck
Introduced in Chapter 529.

zū
to rent
Introduced in Chapter 203.

zuì
most
Introduced in Chapter 140.

zuǐ
mouth; beak
Introduced in Chapter 473.

zuìchū
at the very start; initially
Introduced in Chapter 295.

最好 *zuìhǎo*
had better; it would be best to
Introduced in Chapter 282.

最后 *zuìhòu*
last; finally; in the end
Introduced in Chapter 278.

zuìjìn
lately; recently
Introduced in Chapter 178.

zūnshǒu
to keep to; to abide by
Introduced in Chapter 359.

zūnzhòng
to show respect for; to respect
Introduced in Chapter 363.

zuò
to sit; to travel by
Introduced in Chapter 44.

做 *zuò*
to do; to make
Introduced in Chapter 89.

zuòbì
to cheat in an exam
Introduced in Chapter 495.

zuǒbian
the left; on the left
Introduced in Chapter 82.

zuòcāo
to do a fitness routine; to do physical exercises
Introduced in Chapter 220.

做法 *zuòfǎ*
the way something is done; method
Introduced in Chapter 349.

做饭 *zuòfàn*
to cook
Introduced in Chapter 69.

作家 *zuòjiā*
writer; author
Introduced in Chapter 259.

做客 *zuòkè*
to visit as a guest; to be a guest
Introduced in Chapter 180.

zuòmèng
to dream; to have a dream
Introduced in Chapter 158.

zuòpǐn
a work of art; a piece of writing
Introduced in Chapter 503.

zuótiān
yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 45.

zuòwán
to finish (doing)
Introduced in Chapter 151.

zuòwèi
a seat
Introduced in Chapter 284.

作文 *zuòwén*
essay; composition (at school)
Introduced in Chapter 251.

zuòyè
homework
Introduced in Chapter 79.

作用 *zuòyòng*
effect; function
Introduced in Chapter 370.

zuǒyòu
about; or so (after a number)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

zúqiú
football; soccer
Introduced in Chapter 135.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 *mā má mǎ mà — one syllable, four words*
How many marked tones does Mandarin have, not counting the neutral one? Type the number as a word.

1.2 你 *— "you", and the first character*
Type the Mandarin word, in pinyin with its tone mark, that means 'you' (one person).

1.3 好 *— "good", and what replaces etymology here*
好 is built from two components. Type the meaning of the one on the left.

1.4 你好 *— the greeting, assembled from two things you already have*
You have just been introduced to someone. Type the Mandarin greeting in characters.

1.5 *ní hǎo — why the greeting is not said the way it is written*
A dictionary prints the greeting as nǐ hǎo. Type it in pinyin the way it is actually spoken.

1.6 好 *again — proof, on a character you own, that tone is the word*
Read in the falling fourth tone, 好 stops meaning 'good'. Type its meaning with that tone, in English.

1.7 *Practice — greet someone, and be greeted back*
Someone greets you with 你好. Type your reply in characters.

Chapter 2

2.1 人 *— two strokes, and a person walking*
How many strokes does the character for 'person' have?

2.2 亻 — *the same person, standing sideways*
A character has the narrow upright person component at its left edge. What does that tell you about the word?

2.3 尔 — *a piece that is there for its sound*
When a component is inside a character for its SOUND rather than its meaning, what is it telling you?

2.4 *Putting two pieces together — and reading the result*
In this character, which half points at the MEANING — the left or the right?

2.5 女 — *three strokes, seated*
How many strokes are in the character for 'woman'?

2.6 子 — *three strokes, a child*
What does the three-stroke character with the hooked vertical and a bar across the middle mean?

2.7 *Two pieces again — and a warning about the story*
Does this character have a component that points at its pronunciation?

Chapter 3

3.1 一 — *one stroke, and that is the character*
How many strokes does the character for one have?

3.2 一 — *one, and the number is the strokes*
What is the relationship between the number of strokes in this character and what it means?

3.3 二 — *two bars, and neither is decoration*
In the character for two, which bar is longer — the top or the bottom?

3.4 二 — *two, and a syllable you have met before*
Type the pinyin, with its tone mark, for the number two.

3.5 三 — *three bars, and the pattern's last stand*
In the character for three, which of the three bars is shortest?

3.6 三 — *three, and the end of the easy road*
Do you expect the character for four to have four strokes? Why or why not?

3.7 四 — *a box, and the rule that governs every box*
Which stroke of the box in the character for four is drawn LAST?

3.8 四 — *four, borrowed for its sound*
Why do some buildings in China have no fourth floor?

3.9 五 — *count the strokes and be wrong*
How many strokes does the character for five have?

3.10 五 — *five, and the run is complete*
Which of the five numbers could you have worked out from their strokes alone?

3.11 *Practice — read the numbers off a wall*
A lift panel reads 一 二 三 五. Which floor number is missing, and why?

Chapter 4

4.1 口 — *the box, on its own*
Which stroke of this box is written last?

4.2 口 — *mouth, and a piece you will meet everywhere*
What does this character mean, and what is it a picture of?

4.3 日 — *one bar inside the box*
Does the middle bar go in before or after the bottom bar?

4.4 日 — *the sun, and the day it measures*
This character means two things. What are they, and why are they the same word?

4.5 不 — *four strokes, all of them separate*
How many times do you lift the pen writing this character?

4.6 不 — *how Mandarin says no*
Mandarin has no single word meaning 'no'. So how do you answer no to a yes-or-no question?

4.7 *Practice — one box, two characters, and a refusal*
Why is 不 worth more than one word of vocabulary?

Chapter 5

5.1 是 — *finish the sun, then build under it*
Which character sits on top of this one, and must be finished first?

5.2 是 — *"is", and the nearest thing to "yes"*
Mandarin has no separate word for 'yes'. So how do you say it?

5.3 不是 — *"is not", and the second tone that moves*
不 changes tone before one particular kind of syllable. Which, and what does 不 become?

5.4 *Practice — answering either way*
Mandarin gives you no word for yes and none for no. What does it give you instead?

Chapter 6

6.1 再 — *a bar, a frame, and a line that closes it*
The frame's top, right side and hook are drawn how – as three strokes, or as one?

6.2 见 — *an eye on two legs*
What sits underneath the frame in this character, and where have you seen it before?

6.3 再见 — *the word that says what it means*
Read the goodbye word literally, character by character. What do the two characters say?

6.4 *Practice — a conversation that ends*
You have opened an exchange, answered inside it, and closed it. Which line closes it, in pinyin?

Chapter 7

7.1 早 — *sun on top, one more time*
Which piece of this character is finished before the other, and how many strokes does it take?

7.2 上 — *the same rule, read the other way*
Which stroke of this character is drawn first, and why is it not the short bar?

7.3 早上 — *morning, and a syllable that goes light*
In the pinyin for 'morning', why does the second syllable have no tone mark?

7.4 早上好 — *the greeting was a pattern all along*
Both greetings you now know end in the same character. Which one, and what does it mean on its own?

7.5 *Practice — greeting the time of day*
You meet someone at eight in the morning. You know two greetings that would both be understood. Which one fits the hour?

Chapter 8

8.1 我 — *seven strokes, and an honest admission*
Which stroke of this seven-stroke character is written last?

8.2 我 — *I, me, and saying who you are*
English has two words, 'I' and 'me', and picks between them. How many does Mandarin use?

8.3 名 — *a mouth with something above it*
Which character that you have already written forms the bottom half of this one?

8.4 字 — *a child under a roof*
This character is the word for the thing you have been writing all along. What does it mean?

8.5 名字 — *the word for a name*
The word for 'name' is made of two characters. What does the second one mean on its own?

8.6 *Practice — saying who you are*
In pinyin, what two words do you put in front of your own name to introduce yourself?

Chapter 9

9.1 什 — *both halves are old news*
Name the two pieces of this character, left first.

9.2 么 — *three strokes, and one of them turns*
The middle stroke goes down-left and then sweeps right. Is that one stroke or two?

9.3 什么 — *what*
Every earlier expression in this book gave something to the listener. What does this word do instead?

9.4 *Practice — when you did not catch it*
You did not catch what someone just said. In pinyin, what one word gets it repeated?

Chapter 10

10.1 讠 — *the speech radical*
A character has this component at its left edge. What can you guess about the word?

10.2 谢 — *twelve strokes, and three pieces*
How many pieces does this twelve-stroke character break into, and which one do you write first?

10.3 谢谢 — *said twice*
The two halves of this word are the same character. Are they said the same way?

10.4 不谢 — *answering thanks*
Why is it said bú xiè and not bù xiè?

10.5 *Practice — thanks, and the answer*
This chapter taught you both how to thank someone and how to answer being thanked. How many new characters did that take?

Chapter 11

11.1 请 — *a half that tells you the sound*
One half of this character tells you the meaning. What does the other half tell you?

11.2 请 — *please, and after you*
You hold a door open for someone and say this one word. What are you telling them?

11.3 *Practice — after you*
A character can give you two different kinds of hint at once. What are they?

Chapter 12

12.1 人 — *a person*
Type the Mandarin character for person.

12.2 女 — *female, woman*
Which taught character is the Level 1 word female or woman?

12.3 *Hear* érzi — *son*
What does érzi mean?

12.4 儿 — *fall, then bend and hook*
Write the first character of érzi.

12.5 儿子 — *son on the page*
Write son in Chinese characters.

12.6 *Hear* nǚ'ér — *daughter*
What does nǚ'ér mean?

12.7 女儿 — *daughter on the page*
Write daughter in Chinese characters.

12.8 *Hear* jiā — *home, family*
What two closely linked meanings does jiā carry?

12.9 家 — *roof first, body second*
Which taught component must be completed first when writing 家?

12.10 家 — *home on the page*
Write home or family in one Chinese character.

12.11 *Hear* jiārén — *family members*
What does jiārén mean?

12.12 家人 — *the people of the home*
Write family members in Chinese characters.

12.13 *Retrieve six people and family words*
Write son, daughter, and family members in that order.

12.14 *Payoff — six family words in four skills*
After all four checks pass, write home, person, and family members.

Chapter 13

13.1 *Hear* dà — *big*
What does dà mean?

13.2 大 — *one bar, two falls*
Which stroke comes first in 大?

13.3 大 — *big on the page*
Write dà, big, in Chinese.

13.4 *Hear* dàjiā — *everyone*
What does dàjiā mean?

13.5 大家 — *everyone on the page*
Write everyone in Chinese characters.

13.6 *Hear* xué — *study, learn*
What does xué mean?

13.7 学 — *top, cover, child*
Which familiar character closes 学 at the bottom?

13.8 学 — *study on the page*
Write xué, study or learn, in Chinese.

13.9 *Hear* xuésheng — *student*
What does xuésheng mean?

13.10 生 — *five measured strokes*
Which stroke closes 生?

13.11 学生 — *student on the page*
Write student in Chinese characters.

13.12 *Hear* dàxué — *university*
What does dàxué mean?

13.13 大学 — *university on the page*
Write university in Chinese characters.

13.14 *Hear* dàxuésheng — *university student*
What does dàxuésheng mean?

13.15 大学生 — *university student on the page*
Write university student in Chinese characters.

13.16 *Retrieve six size and school words*
Write student, university, and university student in that order.

13.17 *Payoff — six school words in four skills*
After all four checks pass, write everyone, university, and university student.

Chapter 14

14.1 *Hear* xiǎo — *small*
What does xiǎo mean?

14.2 小 — *centre, left, right*
Which stroke comes first in 小?

14.3 小 — *small on the page*
Write xiǎo, small, in Chinese.

14.4 *Hear* xiǎoxué — *primary school*
What does xiǎoxué mean?

14.5 小学 — *primary school on the page*
Write primary school in Chinese characters.

14.6 *Hear* xiǎoxuésheng — *primary-school student*
What does xiǎoxuésheng mean?

14.7 小学生 — *primary-school student on the page*
Write primary-school student in Chinese characters.

14.8 *Retrieve three primary-school words*
Write small, primary school, and primary-school student in that order.

14.9 *Payoff — three primary-school words in four skills*
After all four checks pass, write primary school and primary-school student.

Chapter 15

15.1 *Hear* zhōng — *middle*
What does zhōng mean?

15.2 中 — *close, then pass through*
What happens immediately before the final centre line in 中?

15.3 中 — *middle on the page*
Write zhōng, middle, in Chinese.

15.4 *Hear* zhōngxué — *middle school*
What does zhōngxué mean?

15.5 中学 — *middle school on the page*
Write middle school in Chinese characters.

15.6 *Retrieval 1 — middle and middle school*
Write middle and middle school in that order.

15.7 *Hear* zhōngxuésheng — *middle-school student*
What does zhōngxuésheng mean?

15.8 中学生 — *middle-school student on the page*
Write middle-school student in Chinese characters.

15.9 *Hear* tóngxué — *classmate*
What does tóngxué mean?

15.10 同 — *frame, line, box*
What three-stroke shape finishes 同?

15.11 同学 — *classmate on the page*
Write classmate in Chinese characters.

15.12 *Retrieval 2 — school and people*
Write middle school, middle-school student, and classmate.

15.13 *Hear* shàngxué — *go to school*
What does shàngxué mean?

15.14 上学 — *go to school on the page*
Write go to school in Chinese characters.

15.15 *Retrieval 3 — place, person, classmate, action*
Write middle school, middle-school student, classmate, and go to school.

15.16 *Retrieval 4 — the full school ladder*
Write primary school, middle school, and university in that order.

15.17 *Payoff — four school compounds in four skills*
After all four checks pass, write middle school, classmate, and go to school.

Chapter 16

16.1 *Hear* zì — *a written character*
What does zì mean on its own?

16.2 字 — *the familiar shape stands alone*
Write zì, a written character, in Chinese.

16.3 *Hear* hànzì — *Chinese character*
What does hànzì mean?

16.4 汉 — *watch five strokes*
After the three water strokes in 汉, what are the last two directions?

16.5 汉 — *copy with a five-part cue*
How many strokes and pen lifts does 汉 use?

16.6 汉 — *hold the route briefly*
Write 汉 after the model has been hidden.

16.7 汉字 — *two known routes, one word*
Read 汉字 without pinyin, then give its meaning.

16.8 *Hear* hànyǔ — *the Chinese language*
Which spoken word means the Chinese language: hànzì or hànyǔ?

16.9 *Retrieval 1* — 字 *and* 汉字
Write written character and Chinese character in that order.

16.10 语 — *speech, five, box*
Which part of 语 is written first, and which small shape closes it?

16.11 语 — *copy, then fade*
After covering half the model, which three-part cue rebuilds 语?

16.12 语 — *wait, then write*
Write 语 from memory. Which component should stay narrow?

16.13 汉语 — *the language in writing*
Read 汉语 without pinyin, then give its meaning.

16.14 *Retrieval 2 — character or language?*
Write Chinese character, then Chinese language.

16.15 *Checkpoint* — 字, 汉字, 汉语
Without pinyin, write character, Chinese character, and Chinese language in that order.

Chapter 17

17.1 *Hear* zhōngwén — *Chinese*
What does zhōngwén mean?

17.2 文 — *watch four open strokes*
Which two directions finish 文?

17.3 文 — *copy with the route visible*
How many strokes and pen lifts does 文 use?

17.4 文 — *wait, then open the two falls*
Write 文 after the model has been hidden.

17.5 中文 — *two known squares*
Read 中文 without pinyin, then give its meaning.

17.6 *Longer return — character or language?*
Write Chinese language, Chinese character, and written character in that order.

17.7 *Hear* zhōngguó — *China*
Which spoken word means China: zhōngwén or zhōngguó?

17.8 国 — *frame, inside, close*
When is the bottom of 国 closed?

17.9 国 — *copy with the frame open*
How many strokes and pen lifts does 国 use?

17.10 国 — *wait before closing*
Write 国 from memory. What must happen before the final bottom bar?

17.11 中国 — *China in two squares*
Read 中国 without pinyin, then give its meaning.

17.12 *Retrieval 1 — language or country?*
Write Chinese language, then China.

17.13 *Longer return — the older three*
Write written character, Chinese language, and Chinese character in that order.

17.14 *Listening score — five meanings*
Which sound means China: zhōngwén or zhōngguó?

17.15 *Reading score — no pinyin*
Read and distinguish 中文 and 中国 without pinyin.

17.16 *Writing score — from sound, no model*
Without a model, write Chinese language with 中, then China.

17.17 *Payoff — five identity words*
Without pinyin or a model, write character, Chinese character, Chinese language with 汉, Chinese language with 中, and China.

Chapter 18

18.1 *Hear* kàn — *look or watch*
What does kàn mean?

18.2 看 — *a hand above an eye*
How many strokes does 看 use?

18.3 看 — *copy hand above, eye below*
What familiar shape finishes 看?

18.4 看 — *wait, then recover the eye*
Write 看 after the model has been hidden.

18.5 看 — *the familiar sound meets the shape*
Read 看, give its meaning, then copy it once.

18.6 *Hear* kànjiàn — *see*
What does kànjiàn mean?

18.7 看见 — *looking reaches seeing*
Write kànjiàn, to see, without pinyin.

18.8 *Hear* hǎokàn — *good-looking*
What does hǎokàn mean?

18.9 好看 — *good to look at*
Write hǎokàn, good-looking, without pinyin.

18.10 *Retrieval 1 — look, see, or good-looking?*
Write look, see, and good-looking in that order.

18.11 *Hear* shū — *book*
What does shū mean?

18.12 书 — *two folds, upright, dot*
How many strokes does 书 use?

18.13 书 — *copy the compact route*
What is the final stroke of 书?

18.14 书 — *wait, then place the dot*
Write 书 after the model has been hidden.

18.15 书 — *the sound meets the shape*
Read 书, give its meaning, then write it once.

18.16 *Hear* kànshū — *read a book*
What does kànshū mean?

18.17 看书 — *look at a book, read*
Write kànshū, read a book, without pinyin.

18.18 *Retrieval 2 — the earlier three return*
Write good-looking, look, and see in that order.

18.19 *Retrieval 1 — book or read a book?*
Write book, then read a book.

18.20 *Listening score — five nearby meanings*
Which sound means read a book: kànjiàn or kànshū?

18.21 *Reading score — no pinyin*
Read 看见 and 看书, then give their meanings.

18.22 *Writing score — sound to Hanzi, no model*
Without a model, write look, see, good-looking, book, and read a book.

18.23 *Payoff — looking and reading*
Without pinyin or a model, write look, see, good-looking, book, and read a book.

Chapter 19

19.1 *Hear* ma *— the syllable that asks*
Which tone does ma carry?

19.2 吗 *— the mouth, then the horse*
How many strokes does 吗 use, and which half is written first?

19.3 吗 *— copy it, and keep the mouth small*
What is the final stroke of 吗?

19.4 吗 *— wait, then write the bar*
Which half of 吗 is completed first?

19.5 吗 *— the sound meets the shape*
Where in the sentence does 吗 go, and what does it change?

19.6 *Hear* nǐ hǎo ma *— how are you*
What does nǐ hǎo ma mean?

19.7 你好吗 *— the greeting, asked*
Write how are you, without pinyin.

19.8 *Retrieval 1 — greeting, or question?*
Write hello, then how are you.

19.9 *Hear* shì ma *— is that so?*
When do you say shì ma?

19.10 是吗 *— checking what you were told*
Write is that so, without pinyin.

19.11 *Hear* hǎo bu hǎo *— the question with the answer inside it*
What three pieces make hǎo bu hǎo?

19.12 好不好 *— the question that needed no new character*
Name Mandarin's two ways of asking a yes-or-no question.

19.13 *Retrieval 2 — which question was that?*
Which of the three does NOT end in 吗?

19.14 *Listening score — catch the question*
How many of the three did you catch by ear alone?

19.15 *Reading score — no pinyin on the card*
Reading cold, what tells you a sentence is a question?

19.16 *Payoff — the book can ask*
Give your four scores as listening, speaking, reading, writing.

Chapter 20

20.1 六 — *four strokes again, for six this time*
How many strokes does 六 have?

20.2 六 — *six, and the run starts again*
Which earlier number shares liu's tone?

20.3 七 — *two strokes, for seven*
How many times do you lift the pen writing 七?

20.4 七 — *seven*
Where is the tongue for the q of qi?

20.5 八 — *a character you have already written twice*
What is the only difference between 八 and 人?

20.6 八 — *eight, and why it costs more*
Why is eight a lucky number in Chinese?

20.7 九 — *two strokes again*
How many strokes do 七, 八 and 九 have between them?

20.8 九 — *nine*
Which tone does jiu share with ni, hao and wu?

20.9 十 — *the character that was already here*
Which character you already write has 十 inside it?

20.10 十 — *ten*
Which tone is shi, and is any other number on it?

20.11 *Payoff — one to ten*
Count aloud from one to ten in Mandarin.

Chapter 21

21.1 十一 — *eleven, and the teens in one line*
Build seventeen from shi and qi.

21.2 二十 — *twenty, and ninety-nine numbers from ten words*
What is the difference between shiyi and ershi?

21.3 百 — *a hundred, on a box you have built before*
Which stroke of 百 comes last?

21.4 一百 — *a hundred, and* 一 *moves*
Is the 一 in yibai said on the same tone as 一 counted alone?

21.5 *5 and* 五 — *the same number, two registers*
A Chinese price tag says 20. How do you say it aloud?

21.6 *Payoff — ninety-nine numbers, and the price tag*
Say sixty-eight and ninety-nine in Mandarin.

21.7 *Close the numeral slice*
Write ten and a hundred in characters.

Chapter 29

29.1 *(reading) — six characters, nothing said first*
Which character is a book?

29.2 *(reading) — six words, not six characters*
Which is the person who reads?

29.3 *(reading) — the first passage*
How old is the writer?

Chapter 30

30.1 很好 — *I'm fine*
Somebody asks you how you are doing. Answer that you are fine.

30.2 *nǐ zěnmeyàng — wǒ hěn hǎo*
In the morning exchange, who says they are busy, A or B?

Chapter 85

85.1 我在这儿 — 你在那儿
Where is the cat?

Chapter 86

86.1 你在哪儿 — 我在那儿
Where is the phone in the end?

Chapter 87

87.1 不 — 没*: two words for not*
Which negative goes with 有, 不 or 没?

87.2 你有没有 — 没有
Has A got a key?

Chapter 88

88.1 *yī → yí ge, yì tiān: the tone* 一 *takes*
Say one person: is 一 rising or falling in front of 个?

88.2 两个人
How many cups of tea does B ask for?

Chapter 89

89.1 给我
Where does the phone go in the end?

Chapter 90

90.1 我会开车
Why can't B drive tomorrow?

Chapter 91

91.1 我想要一点儿水
Does B want tea?

Chapter 92

92.1 我也要
What does C order?

Chapter 93

93.1 太大了
What is wrong with the second one?

Chapter 94

94.1 我们都是学生
Who is the tall, thin man?

Chapter 95

95.1 你为什么不去
Why isn't B going tomorrow?

Chapter 96

96.1 为什么 — 因为
Why isn't B going to class?

Chapter 97

97.1 *(reading) — a Sunday at home*
At what time do they go to buy books?

97.2 *My own line — the first Chinese with no model*
Write the word for an hour, in characters.

Chapter 98

98.1 *The same writing, with a clock*
Write the form label that asks where your home is.

Chapter 147

147.1 明天会下雨 — 会 *for what will happen*
How do you say that it won't rain tomorrow?

147.2 明天会下雨吗 — 后天不会
Which day will it not rain?

Chapter 148

148.1 火车要开了 — 要 *for what is coming*
How do you say that the train is about to leave?

148.2 下个月我要去中国
Where is B going next month?

Chapter 149

149.1 你在做什么 — 在 *before a verb*
How do you ask someone what they are doing right now?

149.2 我正在吃饭
What is A's mum doing?

Chapter 150

150.1 你去过中国吗 — 过 *for what you have done*
How do you say you have not been there?

150.2 你去过吗 — 我没去过
Has A ever been to China?

Chapter 151

151.1 看到 — 没看到*: a verb and its result*
How do you say you looked but did not spot it?

151.2 我看到他了
Did B catch what he was saying?

Chapter 152

152.1 你说得很好 — *how well, with* **得**
How do you say that he speaks Chinese fast?

152.2 他说汉语说得很快
How does A say they speak?

Chapter 153

153.1 他比我大两岁 — *comparing with* **比**
How do you say he is two years older than you?

153.2 我比他大 — **我没有他那么大**
How many years older than B is he?

Chapter 154

154.1 你要水还是要饭
Has B eaten yet?

Chapter 155

155.1 从八点到十点 — *from and to*
How do you say from eight to ten o'clock?

155.2 *(reading) — a timetable and opening hours*
You must be at the university by eleven. At what time does your train leave?

155.3 火车十点半到
What time does the train get to the university?

Chapter 156

156.1 *(reading) — a price list and an advert*
How many yuan do two books cost on Saturday?

156.2 一本书十元
What is free?

Chapter 157

157.1 *(reading) — a notice and a message*
Why can't your friend come tomorrow?

157.2 *A reply, and the lines that lean on each other*
Write the words for 'from two to four o'clock', in characters.

Chapter 278

278.1 先…然后…最后 — *first, then, last*
Which word opens the last step of a story told in order?

278.2 吃了饭以后 — *after doing something*
How do you say 'after we've eaten', in characters?

278.3 先洗手 然后吃早饭
Where does B go straight after breakfast?

Chapter 279

279.1 …的时候 — *when, and what was going on*
How do you say 'when he came', in characters?

279.2 *(reading) — a day on the mountain*
Why did they go to the old man's house?

279.3 他突然来了
Who came while they were looking for the car?

Chapter 280

280.1 我觉得… — *I think*
How do you say 'I think he's right', in characters?

280.2 我觉得这个意见很好
Why does B think he doesn't want to go?

Chapter 281

281.1 因为…所以… — *because, so*
How do you say 'because it rained, we didn't go', in characters?

281.2 *One reason — a line of your own with* 因为 *and* 所以
Write the word for 'so', in characters.

281.3 因为我喜欢中国 所以学汉语
Why is B learning Chinese?

Chapter 282

282.1 你应该… — *you should*
How do you tell someone they should see a doctor, in characters?

282.2 你病了 应该去看医生
Where does B say A had better stay?

Chapter 283

283.1 去…怎么走 — *how do I get there?*
How do you ask the way to the station, in characters?

283.2 去书店怎么走
At the crossing, which way do you turn?

Chapter 284

284.1 坐火车去 — *going by train*
How do you say 'we're going by train', in characters?

284.2 坐在这儿 — 在 *after the verb*
How do you tell someone to sit here, in characters?

284.3 一家书店 — *counting shops with* 家
Which measure word counts a bookshop?

284.4 我们坐八点的火车
Which train are they taking?

Chapter 285

285.1 我的手机不见了 — *it's gone*
How do you say your phone has gone missing, in characters?

285.2 找不到 — *can't find it*
How do you say 'I can't find my phone', in characters?

285.3 *A note to the desk, four lines that lean on each other*
Write the words for 'when I came back', in characters.

285.4 我的车票不见了
When did A still have the ticket?

Chapter 286

286.1 我感觉… — *how it felt*
How do you say 'I felt really happy that day', in characters?

286.2 学了两年 — *how long it lasted*
How do you say 'I studied Chinese for two years', in characters?

286.3 我感觉很好
How long did B study Chinese in China?

Chapter 287

287.1 以后我想… — *later, I want to*
How do you say 'later on I want to go and work in China', in characters?

287.2 我最喜欢… — *the one I like best*
How do you say 'I like Chinese food best', in characters?

287.3 以后我想当医生
Why does B want to be a doctor?

Chapter 288

288.1 要是…就… — *if, then*
How do you say 'if it rains tomorrow, I won't go', in characters?

288.2 看天气 — *it depends on the weather*
How do you say 'it depends on the weather', in characters?

288.3 要是下雨 我就不去了
What will B do if it doesn't rain?

Chapter 289

289.1 如果…就… — *if, then*
After 如果 and the condition, which word opens the result?

289.2 如果…就会… — *what would happen*
How do you say 'if I had the money, I would go to China', in characters?

289.3 *Six lines to a friend, a story with advice at the end*
Write the word for 'suddenly', in characters.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 *mā má mǎ mà — one syllable, four words*
Answer: four
Also accepted: 4

1.2 你 *— "you", and the first character*
Answer: nǐ
Also accepted: ni3; ni

1.3 好 *— "good", and what replaces etymology here*
Answer: woman
Also accepted: female

1.4 你好 *— the greeting, assembled from two things you already have*
Answer: 你好
Also accepted: ni hao; nǐ hǎo; ní hǎo; nihao

1.5 *ní hǎo — why the greeting is not said the way it is written*
Answer: ní hǎo
Also accepted: ni2 hao3; nihao (ní hǎo); ní hao

1.6 好 *again — proof, on a character you own, that tone is the word*
Answer: to be fond of
Also accepted: to like; like; fond of; be fond of

1.7 *Practice — greet someone, and be greeted back*
Answer: 你好
Also accepted: ni hao; nǐ hǎo; ní hǎo; nihao

Chapter 2

2.1 人 — *two strokes, and a person walking*
Answer: 2
Also accepted: two; 2 strokes; two strokes

2.2 亻 — *the same person, standing sideways*
Answer: it is about a person
Also accepted: person; about a person; it involves a person; people

2.3 尔 — *a piece that is there for its sound*
Answer: roughly how the word is pronounced
Also accepted: the pronunciation; how it sounds; the sound; how to say it

2.4 *Putting two pieces together — and reading the result*
Answer: the left
Also accepted: left; left half; the left half

2.5 女 — *three strokes, seated*
Answer: 3
Also accepted: three; 3 strokes; three strokes

2.6 子 — *three strokes, a child*
Answer: child
Also accepted: a child; baby; kid; child, zi

2.7 *Two pieces again — and a warning about the story*
Answer: no
Also accepted: none; neither; no it does not

Chapter 3

3.1 一 — *one stroke, and that is the character*
Answer: 1
Also accepted: one; 1 stroke; one stroke

3.2 一 — *one, and the number is the strokes*
Answer: they are the same
Also accepted: they are the same number; one stroke means one; the same; stroke count equals the number; they match

3.3 二 — *two bars, and neither is decoration*
Answer: the bottom
Also accepted: bottom; lower; the lower one; bottom bar

3.4 二 — *two, and a syllable you have met before*
Answer: èr
Also accepted: er4; er

3.5 三 — *three bars, and the pattern's last stand*
Answer: the middle one
Also accepted: middle; the middle; middle bar; the middle bar; 2nd; second

3.6 三 — *three, and the end of the easy road*
Answer: no
Also accepted: four bars would be unreadable; you would have to count it; stacked bars stop being readable

3.7 四 — *a box, and the rule that governs every box*
Answer: the bottom
Also accepted: bottom; the bottom bar; bottom bar; closing the bottom; the closing bottom stroke

3.8 四 — *four, borrowed for its sound*
Answer: si sounds like the word for die
Also accepted: because si sounds like die; four sounds like death; si and si differ only by tone; it sounds like the word for death

3.9 五 — *count the strokes and be wrong*
Answer: 4
Also accepted: four; 4 strokes; four strokes

3.10 五 — *five, and the run is complete*
Answer: one two and three
Also accepted: 1 2 3; one, two, three; the first three; 一二三; yi er san

3.11 *Practice — read the numbers off a wall*
Answer: four
Also accepted: 4; 四; four, because si sounds like the word for die; four - sounds like die; 4 - unlucky

Chapter 4

4.1 口 — *the box, on its own*
Answer: the bottom
Also accepted: bottom; the bottom bar; bottom bar; closing the bottom

4.2 口 — *mouth, and a piece you will meet everywhere*
Answer: mouth
Also accepted: a mouth; an open mouth; mouth - it is a picture of one

4.3 日 — *one bar inside the box*
Answer: before
Also accepted: before it; before the bottom; the middle comes first

4.4 日 — *the sun, and the day it measures*
Answer: sun and day
Also accepted: sun and day - the sun measures the day; sun, day; the sun and the day it counts

4.5 不 — *four strokes, all of them separate*
Answer: 3
Also accepted: three; 3 times; three times

4.6 不 — *how Mandarin says no*
Answer: negate the word they asked about
Also accepted: by negating the verb; put bu in front of the word; negate what was asked; say bu plus the word

4.7 *Practice — one box, two characters, and a refusal*
Answer: it negates every word you know
Also accepted: it doubles your vocabulary; it turns any word into its opposite; every word gets a negative

Chapter 5

5.1 是 — *finish the sun, then build under it*
Answer: the sun character
Also accepted: 日; ri; the sun; sun

5.2 是 — *"is", and the nearest thing to "yes"*
Answer: echo the word back
Also accepted: repeat it; say it again; echo the word you were asked about

5.3 不是 — *"is not", and the second tone that moves*
Answer: before a fourth tone it becomes rising
Also accepted: before a falling tone, it rises; before 4th tone it becomes 2nd; it becomes second tone before a fourth tone; rising, before a fourth tone

5.4 *Practice — answering either way*
Answer: a word you keep or turn
Also accepted: the word, kept or negated; you echo it or negate it; one word and two things to do with it

Chapter 6

6.1 再 — *a bar, a frame, and a line that closes it*
Answer: one
Also accepted: as one; one stroke; 1; a single stroke; one turning stroke

6.2 见 — *an eye on two legs*
Answer: legs, from the person character
Also accepted: the legs of ren; two legs; the legs from 人; legs; 人

6.3 再见 — *the word that says what it means*
Answer: again see
Also accepted: see again; again, see; zai jian = again see; again + see

6.4 *Practice — a conversation that ends*
Answer: zàijiàn
Also accepted: zaijian; zai jian; zài jiàn; zaijian4; 再见

Chapter 7

7.1 早 — *sun on top, one more time*
Answer: the sun, four strokes
Also accepted: 日, four; the sun character, 4; 日 first, four strokes; 日 in four

7.2 上 — *the same rule, read the other way*
Answer: the vertical, because the bar does not cross it
Also accepted: vertical; the central vertical; the vertical, the bar meets it; the vertical stroke

7.3 早上 — *morning, and a syllable that goes light*
Answer: it is neutral
Also accepted: neutral tone; it lost its tone; it is unstressed; no tone, it is neutral

7.4 早上好 — *the greeting was a pattern all along*
Answer: 好, good
Also accepted: hao, good; 好 means good; 好 - good; the good character

7.5 *Practice — greeting the time of day*
Answer: 早上好
Also accepted: zaoshang hao; zǎoshang hǎo; zaoshanghao; the morning one; good morning

Chapter 8

8.1 我 — *seven strokes, and an honest admission*
Answer: the dot
Also accepted: dot; the upper right dot; the top right dot; the last dot

8.2 我 — *I, me, and saying who you are*
Answer: one
Also accepted: 1; one word; just one; only one

8.3 名 — *a mouth with something above it*
Answer: 口
Also accepted: kou; the mouth; 口 the mouth; mouth

8.4 字 — *a child under a roof*
Answer: character
Also accepted: a character; written character; chinese character; a written word

8.5 名字 — *the word for a name*
Answer: character
Also accepted: a character; written character; zi means character; a written unit

8.6 *Practice — saying who you are*
Answer: wǒ shì
Also accepted: wo shi; wǒshì; wo3 shi4; 我是

Chapter 9

9.1 什 — *both halves are old news*
Answer: the person radical, then ten
Also accepted: 亻 and 十; person and ten; the person, then ten; ren radical and shi

9.2 么 — *three strokes, and one of them turns*
Answer: one
Also accepted: 1; one stroke; a single stroke; one, unbroken

9.3 什么 — *what*
Answer: it asks
Also accepted: asks; it asks a question; asks for something back; it gets something back

9.4 *Practice — when you did not catch it*
Answer: shénme
Also accepted: shenme; shén me; shen2 me; 什么

Chapter 10

10.1 讠 — *the speech radical*
Answer: it is about speech
Also accepted: speech; it involves speaking; something to do with talking; about talking

10.2 谢 — *twelve strokes, and three pieces*
Answer: three, speech first
Also accepted: three, 讠 first; 3, the speech radical; three pieces, speech first; three - speech, body, inch

10.3 谢谢 — *said twice*
Answer: no
Also accepted: not quite; no, the second is light; no - the second goes neutral; they differ

10.4 不谢 — *answering thanks*
Answer: because 谢 is fourth tone
Also accepted: 谢 is fourth tone; bu rises before a fourth tone; the following tone is falling; because of the fourth tone after it

10.5 *Practice — thanks, and the answer*
Answer: one
Also accepted: 1; just one; one character; a single character

Chapter 11

11.1 请 — *a half that tells you the sound*
Answer: the sound
Also accepted: how to say it; the pronunciation; roughly how it sounds; the sound of the word

11.2 请 — *please, and after you*
Answer: go ahead
Also accepted: after you; please, go ahead; be my guest; I invite you to go first

11.3 *Practice — after you*
Answer: meaning and sound
Also accepted: what it means and how it sounds; meaning and pronunciation; sound and meaning; one for meaning, one for sound

Chapter 12

12.1 人 — *a person*
Answer: 人
Also accepted: 人 rén

12.2 女 — *female, woman*
Answer: 女
Also accepted: 女 nǚ

12.3 *Hear* érzi — *son*
Answer: son
Also accepted: a son

12.4 儿 — *fall, then bend and hook*
Answer: 儿
Also accepted: 儿 ér

12.5 儿子 — *son on the page*
Answer: 儿子
Also accepted: 儿子 érzi

12.6 *Hear* nǚ'ér — *daughter*
Answer: daughter
Also accepted: a daughter

12.7 女儿 — *daughter on the page*
Answer: 女儿
Also accepted: 女儿 nǚ'ér

12.8 *Hear* jiā — *home, family*
Answer: home and family
Also accepted: family and home; home; family; household and home

12.9 家 — *roof first, body second*
Answer: 宀
Also accepted: the roof; roof; 宀 roof

12.10 家 — *home on the page*
Answer: 家
Also accepted: 家 jiā

12.11 *Hear* jiārén — *family members*
Answer: family members
Also accepted: family; the people in a family; members of the family

12.12 家人 — *the people of the home*
Answer: 家人
Also accepted: 家人 jiārén

12.13 *Retrieve six people and family words*
Answer: 儿子 — 女儿 — 家人
Also accepted: 儿子 女儿 家人; 儿子, 女儿, 家人

12.14 *Payoff — six family words in four skills*
Answer: 家 — 人 — 家人
Also accepted: 家 人 家人; 家, 人, 家人

Chapter 13

13.1 *Hear* dà — *big*
Answer: big
Also accepted: large; big or large

13.2 大 — *one bar, two falls*
Answer: the horizontal stroke
Also accepted: horizontal; 一; the bar

13.3 大 — *big on the page*
Answer: 大
Also accepted: 大 dà

13.4 *Hear* dàjiā — *everyone*
Answer: everyone
Also accepted: everybody

13.5 大家 — *everyone on the page*
Answer: 大家
Also accepted: 大家 dàjiā

13.6 *Hear* xué — *study, learn*
Answer: study
Also accepted: learn; study or learn; to study; to learn

13.7 学 — *top, cover, child*
Answer: 子
Also accepted: 子 zi; child 子

13.8 学 — *study on the page*
Answer: 学
Also accepted: 学 xué

13.9 *Hear* xuésheng — *student*
Answer: student
Also accepted: a student

13.10 生 — *five measured strokes*
Answer: the long bottom horizontal
Also accepted: bottom horizontal; the bottom bar; horizontal

13.11 学生 — *student on the page*
Answer: 学生
Also accepted: 学生 xuésheng

13.12 *Hear* dàxué — *university*
Answer: university
Also accepted: college; university or college

13.13 大学 — *university on the page*
Answer: 大学
Also accepted: 大学 dàxué

13.14 *Hear* dàxuésheng — *university student*
Answer: university student
Also accepted: college student; a university student; a college student

13.15 大学生 — *university student on the page*
Answer: 大学生
Also accepted: 大学生 dàxuésheng

13.16 *Retrieve six size and school words*
Answer: 学生 — 大学 — 大学生
Also accepted: 学生 大学 大学生; 学生, 大学, 大学生

13.17 *Payoff — six school words in four skills*
Answer: 大家 — 大学 — 大学生
Also accepted: 大家 大学 大学生; 大家, 大学, 大学生

Chapter 14

14.1 *Hear* xiǎo — *small*
Answer: small
Also accepted: little; small or little

14.2 小 — *centre, left, right*
Answer: the centre vertical hook
Also accepted: centre vertical; vertical hook; middle stroke

14.3 小 — *small on the page*
Answer: 小
Also accepted: 小 xiǎo

14.4 *Hear* xiǎoxué — *primary school*
Answer: primary school
Also accepted: elementary school; primary or elementary school

14.5 小学 — *primary school on the page*
Answer: 小学
Also accepted: 小学 xiǎoxué

14.6 *Hear* xiǎoxuésheng — *primary-school student*
Answer: primary-school student
Also accepted: elementary-school student; a primary school student; an elementary school student

14.7 小学生 — *primary-school student on the page*
Answer: 小学生
Also accepted: 小学生 xiǎoxuésheng

14.8 *Retrieve three primary-school words*
Answer: 小 — 小学 — 小学生
Also accepted: 小 小学 小学生; 小, 小学, 小学生

14.9 *Payoff — three primary-school words in four skills*
Answer: 小学 — 小学生
Also accepted: 小学 小学生; 小学, 小学生

Chapter 15

15.1 *Hear* zhōng — *middle*
Answer: middle
Also accepted: centre; center; middle or centre

15.2 中 — *close, then pass through*
Answer: close the box
Also accepted: the box closes; draw the bottom horizontal; close 口

15.3 中 — *middle on the page*
Answer: 中
Also accepted: 中 zhōng

15.4 *Hear* zhōngxué — *middle school*
Answer: middle school
Also accepted: a middle school

15.5 中学 — *middle school on the page*
Answer: 中学
Also accepted: 中学 zhōngxué

15.6 *Retrieval 1 — middle and middle school*
Answer: 中 — 中学
Also accepted: 中 中学; 中, 中学

15.7 *Hear* zhōngxuésheng — *middle-school student*
Answer: middle-school student
Also accepted: a middle school student; middle school student

15.8 中学生 — *middle-school student on the page*
Answer: 中学生
Also accepted: 中学生 zhōngxuésheng

15.9 *Hear* tóngxué — *classmate*
Answer: classmate
Also accepted: schoolmate; a classmate; a schoolmate

15.10 同 — *frame, line, box*
Answer: 口
Also accepted: the inner 口; mouth box; a box

15.11 同学 — *classmate on the page*
Answer: 同学
Also accepted: 同学 tóngxué

15.12 *Retrieval 2 — school and people*
Answer: 中学 — 中学生 — 同学
Also accepted: 中学 中学生 同学; 中学, 中学生, 同学

15.13 *Hear* shàngxué — *go to school*
Answer: go to school
Also accepted: attend school; to go to school; to attend school

15.14 上学 — *go to school on the page*
Answer: 上学
Also accepted: 上学 shàngxué

15.15 *Retrieval 3 — place, person, classmate, action*
Answer: 中学 — 中学生 — 同学 — 上学
Also accepted: 中学 中学生 同学 上学; 中学, 中学生, 同学, 上学

15.16 *Retrieval 4 — the full school ladder*
Answer: 小学 — 中学 — 大学
Also accepted: 小学 中学 大学; 小学, 中学, 大学

15.17 *Payoff — four school compounds in four skills*
Answer: 中学 — 同学 — 上学
Also accepted: 中学 同学 上学; 中学, 同学, 上学

Chapter 16

16.1 *Hear* zì — *a written character*
Answer: a written Chinese character
Also accepted: character; written character; Chinese character

16.2 字 — *the familiar shape stands alone*
Answer: 字
Also accepted: 字 zì

16.3 *Hear* hànzì — *Chinese character*
Answer: Chinese character
Also accepted: a Chinese character; Han character; a Han character

16.4 汉 — *watch five strokes*
Answer: turn down-left, then fall down-right
Also accepted: left then right; down-left then down-right; turn left and fall right

16.5 汉 — *copy with a five-part cue*
Answer: five strokes and four lifts
Also accepted: 5 strokes, 4 lifts; five and four

16.6 汉 — *hold the route briefly*
Answer: 汉
Also accepted: 汉 hàn

16.7 汉字 — *two known routes, one word*
Answer: hànzì — Chinese character
Also accepted: hanzi, Chinese character; Chinese character; hànzì

16.8 *Hear* hànyǔ — *the Chinese language*
Answer: hànyǔ
Also accepted: hanyu; hànyǔ means Chinese language

16.9 *Retrieval 1* — 字 *and* 汉字
Answer: 字 — 汉字
Also accepted: 字 汉字; 字, 汉字

16.10 语 — *speech, five, box*
Answer: 讠 first; 口 closes it
Also accepted: speech radical then box; 讠 then 口; yan first and kou last

16.11 语 — *copy, then fade*
Answer: speech, five, box
Also accepted: 讠 五 口; yan five kou; speech five mouth

16.12 语 — *wait, then write*
Answer: 讠
Also accepted: speech radical; the left side; yan

16.13 汉语 — *the language in writing*
Answer: hànyǔ — the Chinese language
Also accepted: hanyu, Chinese language; Chinese language; hànyǔ

16.14 *Retrieval 2 — character or language?*
Answer: 汉字 — 汉语
Also accepted: 汉字 汉语; 汉字, 汉语

16.15 *Checkpoint* — 字, 汉字, 汉语
Answer: 字 — 汉字 — 汉语
Also accepted: 字 汉字 汉语; 字, 汉字, 汉语

Chapter 17

17.1 *Hear* zhōngwén — *Chinese*
Answer: Chinese; the Chinese language
Also accepted: Chinese; Chinese language; the Chinese language

17.2 文 — *watch four open strokes*
Answer: fall left, then fall right
Also accepted: left then right; down-left then down-right; left-falling then right-falling

17.3 文 — *copy with the route visible*
Answer: four strokes and three lifts
Also accepted: 4 strokes, 3 lifts; four and three

17.4 文 — *wait, then open the two falls*
Answer: 文
Also accepted: 文 wén

17.5 中文 — *two known squares*
Answer: zhōngwén — Chinese; the Chinese language
Also accepted: Chinese; Chinese language; zhongwen; zhōngwén

17.6 *Longer return — character or language?*
Answer: 汉语 — 汉字 — 字
Also accepted: 汉语 汉字 字; 汉语, 汉字, 字

17.7 *Hear* zhōngguó — *China*
Answer: zhōngguó
Also accepted: zhongguo; zhōngguó means China

17.8 国 — *frame, inside, close*
Answer: after every stroke of 玉 inside is finished
Also accepted: last; after the inside; after 玉; after the inner dot

17.9 国 — *copy with the frame open*
Answer: eight strokes and seven lifts
Also accepted: 8 strokes, 7 lifts; eight and seven

17.10 国 — *wait before closing*
Answer: finish 玉 inside
Also accepted: finish the inside; write 玉; complete all inner strokes

17.11 中国 — *China in two squares*
Answer: zhōngguó — China
Also accepted: China; zhongguo; zhōngguó

17.12 *Retrieval 1 — language or country?*
Answer: 中文 — 中国
Also accepted: 中文 中国; 中文, 中国

17.13 *Longer return — the older three*
Answer: 字 — 汉语 — 汉字
Also accepted: 字 汉语 汉字; 字, 汉语, 汉字

17.14 *Listening score — five meanings*
Answer: zhōngguó
Also accepted: zhongguo; zhōngguó means China

17.15 *Reading score — no pinyin*
Answer: 中文 — Chinese language; 中国 — China
Also accepted: 中文 Chinese, 中国 China; Chinese language; China

17.16 *Writing score — from sound, no model*
Answer: 中文 — 中国
Also accepted: 中文 中国; 中文, 中国

17.17 *Payoff — five identity words*
Answer: 字 — 汉字 — 汉语 — 中文 — 中国
Also accepted: 字 汉字 汉语 中文 中国; 字, 汉字, 汉语, 中文, 中国

Chapter 18

18.1 *Hear* kàn — *look or watch*
Answer: look at or watch
Also accepted: look; look at; watch; to look at; to watch

18.2 看 — *a hand above an eye*
Answer: nine
Also accepted: 9; nine strokes

18.3 看 — *copy hand above, eye below*
Answer: 目, the eye shape
Also accepted: 目; eye; the eye component; mu

18.4 看 — *wait, then recover the eye*
Answer: 看
Also accepted: 看 kàn

18.5 看 — *the familiar sound meets the shape*
Answer: kàn — look at or watch — 看
Also accepted: kan look watch 看; kàn look at 看; kàn watch 看

18.6 *Hear* kànjiàn — *see*
Answer: see or catch sight of
Also accepted: see; to see; catch sight of

18.7 看见 — *looking reaches seeing*
Answer: 看见
Also accepted: 看见 kànjiàn

18.8 *Hear* hǎokàn — *good-looking*
Answer: good-looking or nice to look at
Also accepted: good-looking; good looking; nice to look at; pretty

18.9 好看 — *good to look at*
Answer: 好看
Also accepted: 好看 hǎokàn

18.10 *Retrieval 1 — look, see, or good-looking?*
Answer: 看 — 看见 — 好看
Also accepted: 看 看见 好看; 看, 看见, 好看

18.11 *Hear* shū — *book*
Answer: book
Also accepted: a book

18.12 书 — *two folds, upright, dot*
Answer: four
Also accepted: 4; four strokes

18.13 书 — *copy the compact route*
Answer: the dot at the upper right
Also accepted: dot; the dot; upper-right dot

18.14 书 — *wait, then place the dot*
Answer: 书
Also accepted: 书 shū

18.15 书 — *the sound meets the shape*
Answer: shū — book — 书
Also accepted: shu book 书; shū book 书

18.16 *Hear* kànshū — *read a book*
Answer: read a book or read books
Also accepted: read; read a book; read books; to read

18.17 看书 — *look at a book, read*
Answer: 看书
Also accepted: 看书 kànshū

18.18 *Retrieval 2 — the earlier three return*
Answer: 好看 — 看 — 看见
Also accepted: 好看 看 看见; 好看, 看, 看见

18.19 *Retrieval 1 — book or read a book?*
Answer: 书 — 看书
Also accepted: 书 看书; 书, 看书

18.20 *Listening score — five nearby meanings*
Answer: kànshū
Also accepted: kanshu; kànshū means read a book

18.21 *Reading score — no pinyin*
Answer: kànjiàn — see; kànshū — read a book
Also accepted: see; read a book; kànjiàn see, kànshū read; 看见 see 看书 read

18.22 *Writing score — sound to Hanzi, no model*
Answer: 看 — 看见 — 好看 — 书 — 看书
Also accepted: 看 看见 好看 书 看书; 看, 看见, 好看, 书, 看书

18.23 *Payoff — looking and reading*
Answer: 看 — 看见 — 好看 — 书 — 看书
Also accepted: 看 看见 好看 书 看书; 看, 看见, 好看, 书, 看书

Chapter 19

19.1 *Hear* ma *— the syllable that asks*
Answer: none — it is neutral
Also accepted: none; neutral; no tone; neutral tone

19.2 吗 *— the mouth, then the horse*
Answer: six, and the left 口 is written first
Also accepted: six left; 6 left; six, 口 first; 6, kou first

19.3 吗 *— copy it, and keep the mouth small*
Answer: the long horizontal across the right half
Also accepted: the long horizontal; long bar; the wide horizontal; horizontal

19.4 吗 *— wait, then write the bar*
Answer: the left 口
Also accepted: left; 口; the mouth; kou; the left half

19.5 吗 *— the sound meets the shape*
Answer: at the end, and it turns the statement into a yes-or-no question
Also accepted: at the end; end, makes it a question; at the end - question

19.6 *Hear* nǐ hǎo ma *— how are you*
Answer: how are you
Also accepted: how are you?; are you well

19.7 你好吗 *— the greeting, asked*
Answer: 你好吗
Also accepted: 你好吗 nǐ hǎo ma; ni hao ma 你好吗

19.8 *Retrieval 1 — greeting, or question?*
Answer: 你好 — 你好吗
Also accepted: 你好 你好吗; 你好, 你好吗

19.9 *Hear* shì ma *— is that so?*
Answer: after somebody tells you something, to check it and invite them to go on
Also accepted: to check what you were told; really; is that so; to show you heard

19.10 是吗 *— checking what you were told*
Answer: 是吗
Also accepted: 是吗 shì ma; shi ma 是吗

19.11 *Hear* hǎo bu hǎo — *the question with the answer inside it*
Answer: good, not, good
Also accepted: good not good; hao bu hao; the word, its negative, the word again

19.12 好不好 — *the question that needed no new character*
Answer: put 吗 at the end, or say the word, 不, and the word again
Also accepted: ma at the end and verb-not-verb; 吗 or 不; ma, or the word not the word

19.13 *Retrieval 2 — which question was that?*
Answer: 好不好
Also accepted: 好不好 hǎo bu hǎo; hao bu hao; the good-not-good one

19.14 *Listening score — catch the question*
Answer: three of three
Also accepted: 3; 3/3; three; two; 2; one; 1; zero; 0

19.15 *Reading score — no pinyin on the card*
Answer: a 吗 at the end, or a word repeated around 不
Also accepted: 吗 at the end or 不 in the middle; ma or bu; the last character, or the repetition

19.16 *Payoff — the book can ask*
Answer: four separate numbers out of four
Also accepted: 4 4 4 4; 4/4 4/4 4/4 4/4; three four four three; 3 4 4 3

Chapter 20

20.1 六 — *four strokes again, for six this time*
Answer: four
Also accepted: 4; four strokes

20.2 六 — *six, and the run starts again*
Answer: si
Also accepted: 四; sì, four; four

20.3 七 — *two strokes, for seven*
Answer: once
Also accepted: 1; one; once, after the horizontal

20.4 七 — *seven*
Answer: where it is for y in yes
Also accepted: like y; the y position; front, as for y

20.5 八 — *a character you have already written twice*
Answer: the strokes are parted at the top
Also accepted: they do not touch; the gap at the top; 人 joins, 八 does not

20.6 八 — *eight, and why it costs more*
Answer: it sounds like fa, to prosper
Also accepted: it sounds like the word for prosper; fa; sounds like getting rich

20.7 九 — *two strokes again*
Answer: six
Also accepted: 6; six, two each

20.8 九 — *nine*
Answer: third
Also accepted: 3; tone 3; the third, the dip

20.9 十 — *the character that was already here*
Answer: 早
Also accepted: zao; 早, morning; morning

20.10 十 — *ten*
Answer: second, and no
Also accepted: second tone, no others; 2, none; the rise, and it is the only one

20.11 *Payoff — one to ten*
Answer: yī èr sān sì wǔ liù qī bā jiǔ shí
Also accepted: yi er san si wu liu qi ba jiu shi; yī, èr, sān, sì, wǔ, liù, qī, bā, jiǔ, shí

Chapter 21

21.1 十一 — *eleven, and the teens in one line*
Answer: shíqī
Also accepted: shiqi; 十七; shí qī

21.2 二十 — *twenty, and ninety-nine numbers from ten words*
Answer: the order
Also accepted: the order of the two words; ten-one versus two-ten; which comes first

21.3 百 — *a hundred, on a box you have built before*
Answer: the bottom horizontal
Also accepted: the floor; the closing bottom bar; the bottom bar

21.4 一百 — *a hundred, and* 一 *moves*
Answer: no
Also accepted: no, it falls; no — it becomes a fall; it falls

21.5 *5 and* 五 — *the same number, two registers*
Answer: èrshí
Also accepted: ershi; 二十; er shi

21.6 *Payoff — ninety-nine numbers, and the price tag*
Answer: liùshíbā jiǔshíjiǔ
Also accepted: liushiba jiushijiu; liùshíbā, jiǔshíjiǔ; liushiba, jiushijiu

21.7 *Close the numeral slice*
Answer: 十 百
Also accepted: 十, 百; 十百

Chapter 29

29.1 *(reading) — six characters, nothing said first*
Answer: shu
Also accepted: 书; shū

29.2 *(reading) — six words, not six characters*
Answer: kan shu de ren
Also accepted: 看书的人; the reader

29.3 *(reading) — the first passage*
Answer: 18
Also accepted: 十八; eighteen

Chapter 30

30.1 很好 *— I'm fine*
Answer: 我很好
Also accepted: wo hen hao; wǒ hěn hǎo; 很好; hen hao; hěn hǎo

30.2 *nǐ zěnmeyàng — wǒ hěn hǎo*
Answer: B
Also accepted: speaker b; the second speaker

Chapter 85

85.1 我在这儿 — 你在那儿
Answer: outside
Also accepted: wàibian; waibian; outside the house

Chapter 86

86.1 你在哪儿 — 我在那儿
Answer: under the chair
Also accepted: zài yǐzi xiàbian; under a chair; below the chair

Chapter 87

87.1 不 *—* 没*: two words for not*
Answer: 没
Also accepted: mei; méi; 没有

87.2 你有没有 — 没有
Answer: no
Also accepted: méiyǒu; meiyou; 没有; no key

Chapter 88

88.1 *yī → yí ge, yì tiān: the tone* 一 *takes*
Answer: rising
Also accepted: yí; yi2; it rises; rises

88.2 两个人
Answer: 2
Also accepted: two; 两; liǎng bēi; liang bei

Chapter 89

89.1 给我
Answer: in the bag
Also accepted: bāo lǐbian; bao libian; the bag; into the bag

Chapter 90

90.1 我会开车
Answer: work
Also accepted: at work; B is at work; shàngbān; shangban

Chapter 91

91.1 我想要一点儿水
Answer: no
Also accepted: bú yào; bu yao; 不要; no thanks

Chapter 92

92.1 我也要
Answer: dumplings
Also accepted: jiǎozi; jiaozi; water and dumplings; the same as A

Chapter 93

93.1 太大了
Answer: a bit small
Also accepted: too small; small; yǒudiǎnr xiǎo; 有点儿小

Chapter 94

94.1 我们都是学生
Answer: their teacher
Also accepted: the teacher; lǎoshī; laoshi; teacher

Chapter 95

95.1 你为什么不去
Answer: something on
Also accepted: yǒushì; youshi; busy; has something on

Chapter 96

96.1 为什么 — 因为
Answer: not well
Also accepted: unwell; not feeling well; bù shūfu; bu shufu; ill

Chapter 97

97.1 *(reading) — a Sunday at home*
Answer: 2
Also accepted: two; two o'clock; 两点; liǎng diǎn; 2pm

97.2 *My own line — the first Chinese with no model*
Answer: 小时
Also accepted: xiǎoshí; xiaoshi

Chapter 98

98.1 *The same writing, with a clock*
Answer: 家在哪儿
Also accepted: jiā zài nǎr; jia zai nar

Chapter 147

147.1 明天会下雨 — 会 *for what will happen*
Answer: 明天不会下雨
Also accepted: míngtiān bú huì xiàyǔ; mingtian bu hui xiayu; 不会下雨

147.2 明天会下雨吗 — 后天不会
Answer: the day after tomorrow
Also accepted: 后天; hòutiān; houtian; day after tomorrow

Chapter 148

148.1 火车要开了 — 要 *for what is coming*
Answer: 火车要开了
Also accepted: huǒchē yào kāi le; huoche yao kai le; 火车快要开了

148.2 下个月我要去中国
Answer: China
Also accepted: 中国; Zhōngguó; zhongguo; to China

Chapter 149

149.1 你在做什么 — 在 *before a verb*
Answer: 你在做什么
Also accepted: nǐ zài zuò shénme; ni zai zuo shenme; 你正在做什么

149.2 我正在吃饭
Answer: cooking
Also accepted: 做饭; zuò fàn; zuofan; she's cooking; she is cooking

Chapter 150

150.1 你去过中国吗 — 过 *for what you have done*
Answer: 我没去过
Also accepted: wǒ méi qù guo; wo mei qu guo; 没去过

150.2 你去过吗 — 我没去过
Answer: no
Also accepted: 没去过; méi qù guo; mei qu guo; never; no, never

Chapter 151

151.1 看到 — 没看到*: a verb and its result*
Answer: 我看了 没看到
Also accepted: wǒ kàn le, méi kàndào; 没看到; méi kàndào; 我没看到

151.2 我看到他了
Answer: no
Also accepted: méi tīngdǒng; mei tingdong; no, he talks too fast

Chapter 152

152.1 你说得很好 — *how well, with* 得
Answer: 他说汉语说得很快
Also accepted: tā shuō Hànyǔ shuō de hěn kuài; ta shuo hanyu shuo de hen kuai; 他汉语说得很快

152.2 他说汉语说得很快
Answer: slowly
Also accepted: màn; man; hěn màn; slow

Chapter 153

153.1 他比我大两岁 — *comparing with* 比
Answer: 他比我大两岁
Also accepted: tā bǐ wǒ dà liǎng suì; ta bi wo da liang sui

153.2 我比他大 — 我没有他那么大
Answer: two
Also accepted: 2; 两岁; liǎng suì; two years

Chapter 154

154.1 你要水还是要饭
Answer: no
Also accepted: 还没; hái méi; hai mei; not yet

Chapter 155

155.1 从八点到十点 — *from and to*
Answer: 从八点到十点
Also accepted: cóng bā diǎn dào shí diǎn; cong ba dian dao shi dian; 从8点到10点

155.2 *(reading) — a timetable and opening hours*
Answer: 8
Also accepted: eight; 8am; eight o'clock; 八点; bā diǎn; 早上八点

155.3 火车十点半到
Answer: 10:30
Also accepted: half past ten; 十点半; shí diǎn bàn; 10.30; ten thirty

Chapter 156

156.1 *(reading) — a price list and an advert*
Answer: 15
Also accepted: fifteen; 十五; 十五元; shíwǔ; shíwǔ kuài; 15 yuan

156.2 一本书十元
Answer: water
Also accepted: 水; shuǐ; shui; the water

Chapter 157

157.1 *(reading) — a notice and a message*
Answer: the mother is ill
Also accepted: mother is ill; her mum is ill; his mum is ill; 妈妈病了; 因为我妈妈病了; mum is ill; their mother is ill

157.2 *A reply, and the lines that lean on each other*
Answer: 从两点到四点
Also accepted: cóng liǎng diǎn dào sì diǎn; cong liang dian dao si dian

Chapter 278

278.1 先…然后…最后 *— first, then, last*
Answer: 最后
Also accepted: zuìhòu; zuihou

278.2 吃了饭以后 *— after doing something*
Answer: 吃了饭以后
Also accepted: chī le fàn yǐhòu; chi le fan yihou

278.3 先洗手 然后吃早饭
Answer: school
Also accepted: to school; 学校; 去学校; xuéxiào; xuexiao; goes to school

Chapter 279

279.1 …的时候 — *when, and what was going on*
Answer: 他来的时候
Also accepted: tā lái de shíhou; ta lai de shihou

279.2 *(reading) — a day on the mountain*
Answer: it rained
Also accepted: because it rained; it was raining; 下雨了; 突然下雨了; the rain; they had no raincoats; 没有雨衣

279.3 他突然来了
Answer: an old man
Also accepted: old man; 一个老人; 老人; lǎorén; an old person; a man

Chapter 280

280.1 我觉得… — *I think*
Answer: 我觉得他说得对
Also accepted: wǒ juéde tā shuō de duì; wo juede ta shuo de dui

280.2 我觉得这个意见很好
Answer: he's too tired
Also accepted: too tired; tired; tài lèi; tā tài lèi le; he is tired

Chapter 281

281.1 因为…所以… — *because, so*
Answer: 因为下雨了所以我们没去
Also accepted: 因为下雨了 所以我们没去; yīnwèi xiàyǔ le, suǒyǐ wǒmen méi qù; yinwei xiayu le suoyi women mei qu

281.2 *One reason — a line of your own with* 因为 *and* 所以
Answer: 所以
Also accepted: suǒyǐ; suoyi

281.3 因为我喜欢中国 所以学汉语
Answer: because B likes China
Also accepted: likes China; they like China; 因为我喜欢中国; 喜欢中国; xǐhuan Zhōngguó; because they like China; he likes China; she likes China

Chapter 282

282.1 你应该… — *you should*
Answer: 你应该去看医生
Also accepted: nǐ yīnggāi qù kàn yīshēng; ni yinggai qu kan yisheng; 你应该看医生

282.2 你病了 应该去看医生
Answer: at home
Also accepted: home; 在家; zài jiā; stay at home; 家

Chapter 283

283.1 去…怎么走 — *how do I get there?*
Answer: 去火车站怎么走
Also accepted: qù huǒchēzhàn zěnme zǒu; qu huochezhan zenme zou; 请问去火车站怎么走

283.2 去书店怎么走
Answer: right
Also accepted: to the right; yòu; you; wǎng yòu guǎi; turn right; right turn

Chapter 284

284.1 坐火车去 — *going by train*
Answer: 我们坐火车去
Also accepted: wǒmen zuò huǒchē qù; women zuo huoche qu

284.2 坐在这儿 — 在 *after the verb*
Answer: 你坐在这儿
Also accepted: nǐ zuò zài zhèr; ni zuo zai zher; 坐在这儿

284.3 一家书店 — *counting shops with* 家
Answer: 家
Also accepted: jiā; jia; 一家; 这家

284.4 我们坐八点的火车
Answer: the eight o'clock
Also accepted: eight; 8; 八点; bā diǎn; eight o'clock; the 8 o'clock; 8:00

Chapter 285

285.1 我的手机不见了 — *it's gone*
Answer: 我的手机不见了
Also accepted: wǒ de shǒujī bú jiàn le; wo de shouji bu jian le; 手机不见了

285.2 找不到 — *can't find it*
Answer: 我找不到我的手机
Also accepted: wǒ zhǎo bu dào wǒ de shǒujī; wo zhao bu dao wo de shouji; 找不到我的手机

285.3 *A note to the desk, four lines that lean on each other*
Answer: 我回来的时候
Also accepted: wǒ huílai de shíhou; wo huilai de shihou; 回来的时候

285.4 我的车票不见了
Answer: when sitting down here
Also accepted: when A sat down; sitting here; when sitting here; 坐在这儿的时候; when I sat here; when they sat down here; on getting on; when getting on

Chapter 286

286.1 我感觉… — *how it felt*
Answer: 那天我感觉很开心
Also accepted: nà tiān wǒ gǎnjué hěn kāixīn; na tian wo ganjue hen kaixin; 我感觉很开心

286.2 学了两年 — *how long it lasted*
Answer: 我学了两年汉语
Also accepted: wǒ xué le liǎng nián Hànyǔ; wo xue le liang nian hanyu

286.3 我感觉很好
Answer: a year
Also accepted: one year; 1 year; 一年; yì nián; yi nian; for a year

Chapter 287

287.1 以后我想… — *later, I want to*
Answer: 以后我想去中国工作
Also accepted: yǐhòu wǒ xiǎng qù Zhōngguó gōngzuò; yihou wo xiang qu zhongguo gongzuo

287.2 我最喜欢… — *the one I like best*
Answer: 我最喜欢中国菜
Also accepted: wǒ zuì xǐhuan Zhōngguó cài; wo zui xihuan zhongguo cai

287.3 以后我想当医生
Answer: B's mother is a doctor
Also accepted: mother is a doctor; their mum is a doctor; 因为我妈妈是医生; 妈妈是医生; because their mother is a doctor; her mother is a doctor; his mother is a doctor

Chapter 288

288.1 要是…就… — *if, then*
Answer: 要是明天下雨我就不去了
Also accepted: 要是明天下雨 我就不去了; yàoshi míngtiān xiàyǔ, wǒ jiù bú qù le; yaoshi mingtian xiayu wo jiu bu qu le

288.2 看天气 — *it depends on the weather*
Answer: 要看天气
Also accepted: 看天气; yào kàn tiānqì; kàn tiānqì; yao kan tianqi

288.3 要是下雨 我就不去了
Answer: go
Also accepted: go up the mountain; 去; 我就去; jiù qù; go to the mountain; B will go; he will go; she will go; they will go

Chapter 289

289.1 如果…就… — *if, then*
Answer: 就
Also accepted: jiù; jiu

289.2 如果…就会… — *what would happen*
Answer: 如果我有钱我就会去中国
Also accepted: 如果我有钱 我就会去中国; rúguǒ wǒ yǒu qián, wǒ jiù huì qù Zhōngguó; ruguo wo you qian wo jiu hui qu zhongguo

289.3 *Six lines to a friend, a story with advice at the end*
Answer: 突然
Also accepted: tūrán; turan

Sources for this starter edition

Character shapes, components, and stroke order follow this project's curated character inventory, whose stroke orders are marked authoritative because Chinese stroke order is a standardised taught system rather than a convention. Codepoint and glyph references are to the Unicode CJK Unified Ideographs chart.

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

A

A Baby on the Way
chapter topic; Chapter 302, p. 2373
a ball game (a football or basketball match) 球赛 (qiúsài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3821
a bit (of something unwanted); rather 有点儿 (yǒudiǎnr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 797
a building of several floors; a floor *lóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1647
A Busy Platform
chapter topic; Chapter 406, p. 3135
A Career
chapter topic; Chapter 487, p. 3727
A Change of Plan
chapter topic; Chapter 392, p. 3031
a checked pattern; squares 格子 (gézi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 4023
A Crash
chapter topic; Chapter 296, p. 2329
a cup of; a glass of (a measure word) *bēi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 749
A Day at the Sea
chapter topic; Chapter 227, p. 1789
A Day from Morning to Night
chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 447
a day's schedule *rìchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 3023

a deposit paid in advance *yājīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1623
a dream (for your life); an aspiration *mèngxiǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 2253
a favourable deal (for customers) *yōuhuì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 4023
A Fire
chapter topic; Chapter 298, p. 2343
a form to fill in *biǎogé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1521
a goal; a target *mùbiāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 2253
A Good Guest, a Good Host
chapter topic; Chapter 361, p. 2805
a great river; big river *jiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 3395
a happy occasion; a wedding in the family 喜事 (xǐshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2395
A Headache
chapter topic; Chapter 228, p. 1795
a home near a good school 学区房 (xuéqūfáng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2921
a hundred — and the one word in the run whose tone moves 一百 (yìbǎi)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 21, p. 213
A Knock at the Door
chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 1433
a large amount of; in large amounts 大量 (dàliàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 4015
A Legend
chapter topic; Chapter 328, p. 2561
a light switch; a switch on a machine 开关 (kāiguān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3971
a little; a bit 一点儿 (yìdiǎnr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 779
a little while; in a moment 一会儿 (yíhuìr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
a local speciality; a regional product *tèchǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1927
a long time; ages *hǎojiǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1493
a long while; half a day 半天 (bàntiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1161

A Lucky Escape
chapter topic; Chapter 531, p. 4049
(a measure word for animals, and for one of a pair) *zhī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 749
(a measure word for books) *běn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 749
(a measure word for flat things: tables, beds, tickets) *zhāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 749
a member of a club or a shop's scheme *huìyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 4023
A Missed Chance
chapter topic; Chapter 356, p. 2767
a moment ago *gāngcái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 1035
A Mountain Village
chapter topic; Chapter 440, p. 3379
A Name and a School
chapter topic; Chapter 303, p. 2381
A New Job
chapter topic; Chapter 276, p. 2133
A New Place
chapter topic; Chapter 316, p. 2477
A New Term
chapter topic; Chapter 248, p. 1935
a new year print (hung at the spring festival) 年画 (niánhuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3843
A Note About Tomorrow
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 1293
A note to the desk, four lines that lean on each other
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 285, p. 2231
a pair of (a measure word) *shuāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 911
a panda; giant panda *xióngmāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1761
A Part-Time Job
chapter topic; Chapter 255, p. 1989
a patient's condition; how an illness is going 病情 (bìngqíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3687
a person's height; body height 身高 (shēngāo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3643
a person's life; life from birth to death 人生 (rénshēng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2477
a person's luck (good or bad) 运气 (yùnqi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 4035

a person's quality; upbringing *sùzhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2915
a pity; it's a shame *kěxī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 2051
a pity; regrettable *yíhàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 2243
a platform (at a station) *zhàntái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 2219
a player in a ball game *qiúyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3815
a position in a firm *zhíwèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3741
a prize you win; an award *jiǎngpǐn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 4043
a rain shower *zhènyǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1909
A reply, and the lines that lean on each other
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 157, p. 1293
a restaurant's signature dish *zhāopáicài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 3457
a romantic date; an appointment (to meet) 约会 (yuēhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 3001
a seat *zuòwèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 2219
a sense of security 安全感 (ānquángǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2949
a small amount of 少量 (shǎoliàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 4015
a snowy landscape *xuějǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3963
a sports team (in a ball game) *qiúduì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3815
A Spring Outing
chapter topic; Chapter 431, p. 3315
A Storm
chapter topic; Chapter 416, p. 3205
A Storm Coming
chapter topic; Chapter 244, p. 1909
a strange business; an odd thing 怪事 (guàishì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 539, p. 4109
a suggestion; an objection 意见 (yìjiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 2173
A Thief
chapter topic; Chapter 309, p. 2425

A Trip Abroad
chapter topic; Chapter 213, p. 1693
a way of doing things; a mode *fāngshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2979
a way to deal with it *bànfǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1699
a way to solve a problem; means 方法 (fāngfǎ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 3507
A wider school map
chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 137
a windbreaker; a light coat against the wind 风衣 (fēngyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1725
a wish one has; a desire 愿望 (yuànwàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 535, p. 4079
a work of art; a piece of writing *zuòpǐn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3843
a written Chinese character, recovered without pinyin 字 (zì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 147
ability *nénglì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 2025
able to do everything; all-purpose 万能 (wànnéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 3039
about; almost *chàbuduō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1637
about; or so (after a number) *zuǒyòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1637
abroad; overseas 国外 (guówài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 2031
accent 口音 (kǒuyīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 3351
accident 事故 (shìgù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 4109
accidental; happening by chance *ǒurán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 4029
accommodation; a place to stay *zhùsù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 3273
actor; performer *yǎnyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 2071
Actors and Jokes
chapter topic; Chapter 267, p. 2071
actually; as a matter of fact *qíshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 2051
address *dìzhǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 997

admission ticket 门票 (ménpiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1693
adult; grown-up 大人 (dàren)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 2065
advanced; high-level 高级 (gāojí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3791
advert; advertisement *guǎnggào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1283
aeroplane *fēijī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 621
affection between people; feelings for each other 感情 (gǎnqíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 3521
after (a time); after (an event) *zhīhòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1493
after; afterwards *yǐhòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 835
after all; all things considered *bìjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2873
after; behind; later *hòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 699
after the event; in hindsight 事后 (shìhòu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 2319
After the Meal
chapter topic; Chapter 452, p. 3473
After You
chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 103
afternoon *xiàwǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 447
afternoon nap 午觉 (wǔjiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1383
afternoon tea (a light meal) 下午茶 (xiàwǔchá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1361
afterwards; later (in the past) 后来 (hòulái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1219
again (still to come); once more 再 (zài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 2207
Age, and And
chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 269
Age and Growing Up
chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 669
age (of a person) *niánjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 669
air *kōngqì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2943

air conditioner; air conditioning *kōngtiáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1399
air temperature *qìwēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1733
airport *jīchǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 3105
airport terminal *hángzhànlóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 3199
alarm; a warning siren 警报 (jǐngbào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2439
alarm clock *nàozhōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1173
all at once; in no time 一下子 (yíxiàzi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 2159
all; both 都 (dōu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 807
all day; round the clock 全天 (quántiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 3061
all; every *suǒyǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1127
all of it; the whole 全部 (quánbù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 3365
all of one mind; in agreement *yízhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2709
all one's life; a lifetime 一生 (yìshēng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2519
All the Same
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 807
all together; together (in everyday speech) *yíkuàir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1339
already *yǐjīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 1035
also; too 也 (yě)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 787
Although
chapter topic; Chapter 371, p. 2879
although 虽然 (suīrán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2879
altogether; in all *yígòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 1083
amazing; remarkable 了不起 (liǎobuqǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2857
ambition in life; the goal one sets oneself *zhìxiàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3911

Ambitions
chapter topic; Chapter 513, p. 3917
ambulance *jiùhùchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1831
America; the United States *Měiguó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 343
An Accident
chapter topic; Chapter 232, p. 1831
an activity; an organised event *huódòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2915
an example *lìzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 2183
an experience (something lived through) *jīnglì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1927
an impatient sort; a hothead *jíxìngzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3595
An Invitation
chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 1411
An Island
chapter topic; Chapter 444, p. 3411
An Ordinary Day
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 1445
ancient; age-old 古老 (gǔlǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2511
ancient book; old book 古书 (gǔshū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2511
ancient times 古代 (gǔdài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2525
ancient walled town; old town 古城 (gǔchéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 3425
and thereby; and in this way *cóng'ér*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 538, p. 4103
anew; over again from the start 重新 (chóngxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 2319
Angry and Worried
chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 1029
animal *dòngwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1761
Animals
chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 1761; Chapter 223, p. 1761
annoyed; fed up *fán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 3515
annual leave 年假 (niánjià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 2043

answer to a question *dá'àn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 2079
anxious; in a hurry *zháojí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 1029
Anyway
chapter topic; Chapter 372, p. 2887
anyway; in any case *fǎnzhèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2887
appearance; manner *yàngzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1837
appetite *wèikǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3657
apple *píngguǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 375
approximately; roughly (a time or number) 大约 (dàyuē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 3015
arm *gēbo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3635
Around the House
chapter topic; Chapter 520, p. 3971
Around the World
chapter topic; Chapter 326, p. 2547
Around Town
chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 855
Arrivals
chapter topic; Chapter 419, p. 3227
Art
chapter topic; Chapter 503, p. 3843
art exhibition *huàzhǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3835
art; the arts *yìshù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3843
as before; even now *réngrán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2469
as far as one can *jǐnliàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 534, p. 4073
as if; to look like (a guess) *hǎoxiàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 2173
As It Turns Out
chapter topic; Chapter 537, p. 4095
as long as; provided (that) 只要 (zhǐyào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 3083
as luck would have it; coincidentally *pèngqiǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 4029

as one would wish 如意 (rúyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 532, p. 4057
as planned (on the agreed date) 如期 (rúqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 3015
As We Agreed
chapter topic; Chapter 390, p. 3015
as you like; casual *suíbiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 2127
Asking
chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 185
Asking for Help
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 1699; Chapter 214, p. 1699
asking what somebody likes, out of four words the book already had 你喜欢什么 (nǐ xǐhuan shénme)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 28, p. 279
at any time; whenever needed *suíshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 3039
at ease; free and relaxed 自在 (zìzai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2469
At Home
chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 503
at least *zhìshǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2857
at long last *zhōngyú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 2313
at night *yèli*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1179
at once; right away 马上 (mǎshàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 705
at regular intervals; periodically 定期 (dìngqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 3015
At School
chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 677
at that time; then *dāngshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1505
At the Bank
chapter topic; Chapter 195, p. 1567
At the Dentist
chapter topic; Chapter 473, p. 3627
at the last minute; for the time being *línshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 3023
At the Market
chapter topic; Chapter 448, p. 3441

at the same time (said twice, before two verbs); one side 一边 (yìbiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1209
At the Station
chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 3105; Chapter 402, p. 3105
At the Till
chapter topic; Chapter 202, p. 1617
At the Top
chapter topic; Chapter 435, p. 3343
at the very start; initially *zuìchū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 2319
At Your Service
chapter topic; Chapter 525, p. 4005
athlete *yùndòngyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3829
attentive and thorough (of service) *zhōudào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 4005
attentive; putting your heart into it 用心 (yòngxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 2115
attitude *tàidu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 3077
auntie; mother's sister *āyí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 2107
authentic; the real thing (of food) *zhèngzōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 3457
autumn *qiūtiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 3931

B

baby; darling (said to a small child) *bǎobao*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 2065
Back From a Trip
chapter topic; Chapter 247, p. 1927
Back Next Month
chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1537
Back Then
chapter topic; Chapter 322, p. 2519
back then; in those years 当年 (dāngnián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2519
backpack; rucksack *bēibāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 3481
bag *bāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 511

bag; sack *dàizi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 989
Bags and Boxes
chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 989
Bags and Cases
chapter topic; Chapter 453, p. 3481
balcony *yángtái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1311
band (of musicians) *yuèduì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3867
bank *yínháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 855
bank account *zhànghù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1567
basis; what something rests on *gēnjù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2723
basketball *lánqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1107
bathroom *yùshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1465
battery *diànchí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1661
Be Sure To
chapter topic; Chapter 393, p. 3039
be sure to (urging); whatever you do 千万 (qiānwàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 3039
beard; moustache *húzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1837
Because
chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 827
because 因为 (yīnwèi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 827
Because of the Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 1113
Becoming Green
chapter topic; Chapter 384, p. 2971
bed *chuáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 737
Bed and Bath
chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 1465
bed sheet *chuángdān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 3287
bedroom *wòshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1311

bee; honeybee *mìfēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1767
beef *niúròu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1325
beer *píjiǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 869
before (a time); before (an event) *zhīqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1493
before; ago; front 前 (qián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 669
before; in the past 以前 (yǐqián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 1035
before one's eyes; right now 眼前 (yǎnqián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3611
beforehand; in advance 事先 (shìxiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2687
behind; at the back *hòubian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 935
Behind, Left and Right
chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 699
Beijing *Běijīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 343
Beijing opera *Jīngjù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3867
belly; tummy *dùzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1811
beloved; treasured 心爱 (xīn'ài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 3535
below zero *língxià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1747
benefit; advantage *hǎochu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2893
besides; in addition *lìngwài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2865
Best Wishes
chapter topic; Chapter 337, p. 2629
bicycle *zìxíngchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 897
big deal; important matter 大事 (dàshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 2133
big fire; a fire that destroys buildings *huǒzāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 2343
big hotel 酒店 (jiǔdiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 3273

big; large, now read and written 大 (dà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 121
bill (to pay) *zhàngdān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2995
bird *niǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 1761
birthday 生日 (shēngrì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 647
biscuit; cracker *bǐnggān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 869
bitter *kǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1405
bitterly cold (of a climate) *hánlěng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3931
black; dark *hēi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 525
black tea *hóngchá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1361
bland; weak (in taste) *dàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1405
blessing; good wishes *zhùfú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2675
Blood
chapter topic; Chapter 479, p. 3671
blood 血 (xiě)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3671
blood pressure *xuèyā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3671
blue *lán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 525
boarding pass *dēngjīpái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 3199
boat; ship *chuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1789
Body and Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 485, p. 3713
body and mind 身心 (shēnxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3713
body; health *shēntǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 455
body temperature *tǐwēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1915
body weight 体重 (tǐzhòng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1811

boiled water; boiling water 开水 (kāishuǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1361
bone *gǔtou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3657
book, recovered without pinyin 书 (shū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 171
Booking a Room
chapter topic; Chapter 200, p. 3281; Chapter 426, p. 3281
books on the shelves (of a library or bookshop) 图书 (túshū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 3487
bookshelf *shūjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1425
bookshop 书店 (shūdiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1529
bored; boring *wúliáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 2099
Born and Married
chapter topic; Chapter 254, p. 1983
boss; owner (of a business) *lǎobǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1989
bottle *píngzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1499
bound to happen; hard to avoid *nánmiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 540, p. 4117
box; small case *hézi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 989
box; suitcase; trunk *xiāngzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 989
boxed meal; packed lunch *héfàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1473
boy 男孩 (nánhái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 2065
brain *dànǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3657
brave *yǒnggǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 2057
bread *miànbāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 375
breakfast 早饭 (zǎofàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 601
bride *xīnniáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 2401
bridegroom *xīnláng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2395

bridge *qiáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1921
bright idea; idea of what to do *zhǔyi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2701
Britain; the United Kingdom *Yīngguó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 343
brochure; leaflet *xuānchuáncè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 3487
broken; bad *huài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 875
brothers *xiōngdì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3873
Brothers and Sisters
chapter topic; Chapter 508, p. 3881
brown *zōngsè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1673
budget *yùsuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2995
buffet *zìzhùcān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 3287
bus stop sign *zhànpái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 3149
business; trade 生意 (shēngyi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2659
Busy and Quiet
chapter topic; Chapter 432, p. 3323
but; however 但是 (dànshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2865
but; yet 可是 (kěshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2835
butterfly *húdié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1767
buyer 买家 (mǎijiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3989
Buying and Selling
chapter topic; Chapter 523, p. 3989
buying and selling for a living; a business deal 买卖 (mǎimai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3989
By Bus
chapter topic; Chapter 408, p. 3149
By Chance
chapter topic; Chapter 528, p. 4029
By the Sea
chapter topic; Chapter 445, p. 3419

bye-bye *bàibai*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655

C

cake *dàngāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 647
calligraphy 书法 (shūfǎ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3843
Calls and Confidence
chapter topic; Chapter 319, p. 2497
calm; cool-headed 冷静 (lěngjìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3573
calm; peaceful inside *píngjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3573
can (having learned how) 会 (huì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 2025
can; to be able to; to be allowed to 能 (néng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 2025
car park *tíngchēchǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1545
car; vehicle 车 (chē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 405
career; life's work 事业 (shìyè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3727
Careful!
chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 963
careful; attentive to detail *xìxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 2115
careless *cūxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 2115
cash *xiànjīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 957
cat *māo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 1761
cause of an illness 病因 (bìngyīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3687
cause of death 死因 (sǐyīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 2357
Celebrating
chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 647
cemetery; graveyard *mùdì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2463

central heating *nuǎnqì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3971
certainly; definitely *yídìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1187
chair *yǐzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 503
champion *guànjūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3829
chance; opportunity 机会 (jīhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 2133
Changing Seasons
chapter topic; Chapter 243, p. 1903
Changing the Subject
chapter topic; Chapter 354, p. 2753
Character or language?
chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 147
characteristic; a distinguishing trait 特点 (tèdiǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 3457
cheap *piányi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 391
Checking In
chapter topic; Chapter 418, p. 3219
checkout; till *shōuyíntái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1617
cheerful and outgoing *kāilǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3581
chef; professional cook *chúshī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3735
chemist's; pharmacy *yàodiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1529
chicken meat; chicken (as food) *jīròu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1325
child *háizi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 321
child; kid 小孩 (xiǎohái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1975
childhood *tóngnián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 2085
childhood pet name 小名 (xiǎomíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 2381
China 中国 (zhōngguó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 159
Chinese (as a school subject) 语文 (yǔwén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3763

Chinese cabbage 白菜 (báicài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 861
Chinese character; Han character 汉字 (hànzì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 147
Chinese; the Chinese language 中文 (zhōngwén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 159
chopsticks *kuàizi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 861
chronic (of an illness) *mànxìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3701
cinema *diànyǐngyuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1529
citizenship; the country one belongs to *guójí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 3495
city *chéngshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 691
city bus *gōngjiāochē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 897
city centre *shìzhōngxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1679
city wall; the wall round a city *chéngqiáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 3425
civilization 文明 (wénmíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2547
classmate; schoolmate, now read and written 同学 (tóngxué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 137
classroom *jiàoshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 677
clean *gānjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 797
Clean Air
chapter topic; Chapter 380, p. 2943
clear and cloudless (of the sky) *qínglǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3955
clear; clearly *qīngchu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1241
clever; bright *cōngming*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 1017
climate 气候 (qìhòu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1903
Clock Words
chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 1161
Close Family
chapter topic; Chapter 511, p. 3903

Clothes
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 519
clothes *yīfu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 511
clothing size; shoe size *chǐmǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1597
cloud 云 (yún)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1733
cloudy 多云 (duōyún)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1733
Cloudy Tomorrow
chapter topic; Chapter 219, p. 1733
coach; long-distance bus 客车 (kèchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 3149
Coats and Scarves
chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 1353
coffee *kāfēi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 489
cola *kělè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 869
cold *lěng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 461
cold starter; cold dishes (on a menu) 冷菜 (lěngcài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1473
colleague 同事 (tóngshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1989
college entrance exam 高考 (gāokǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3777
colour *yánsè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 525
Colours
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 525
Colours and Shapes
chapter topic; Chapter 139, p. 1135
Colours and Styles
chapter topic; Chapter 210, p. 1673
comfortable; well *shūfu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 827
Coming and Going
chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 397
Coming Over
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 1459
Comings and Goings
chapter topic; Chapter 427, p. 3287

community; neighbourhood 社区 (shèqū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2921
company; firm *gōngsī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 685
compassion; love and care for others 爱心 (àixīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 3535
complexion; the colour of one's face 脸色 (liǎnsè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3619
computer *diànnǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 511
concert 音乐会 (yīnyuèhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 1051
conclusion *jiélùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2879
condition (that must be met) *tiáojiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 3053
confidence; faith 信心 (xìnxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2497
conscientious; serious *rènzhēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 1017
consequences; what comes of it 后果 (hòuguǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 4109
considerate; thoughtful of others' needs *tǐtiē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3589
content; what something is about *nèiróng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2753
contract; written agreement *hétong*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1623
convenient; handy *fāngbiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 1059
cooked rice *mǐfàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 359
cooked rice; meal 饭 (fàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 359
Cooking
chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 951
Country Life
chapter topic; Chapter 439, p. 3373
country; nation 国家 (guójiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2547
courage; nerve *dǎnzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2591
credit card *xìnyòngkǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1567

crossroads; junction *lùkǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 935
crowded *yōngjǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 3135
crystal-clear (of water) *qīngchè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 3403
culture *wénhuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2901
cup; glass *bēizi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 511
cupboard; cabinet *guìzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1425
curtain *chuānglián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1465
custom; social custom *fēngsú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2637
customer *gùkè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1617
Customs
chapter topic; Chapter 417, p. 3213
customs at the border *hǎiguān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 3213
cute; lovable *kě'ài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 1017
CV; résumé *jiǎnlì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3721

D

D-class bullet train *dòngchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 3141
dad; father *bàba*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 313
damp; humid *cháoshī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1725
dance partner *wǔbàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3859
dance party; ball 舞会 (wǔhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3859
Dancing
chapter topic; Chapter 505, p. 3859
dangerous *wēixiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 963

dark clouds *wūyún*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1871
date 日期 (rìqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 429
daughter, now read and written 女儿 (nǚ'ér)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 111
Day and Night
chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 1179
day; days (of one's life) 日子 (rìzi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1445
day of the month; number (in a series) 号 (hào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1521
day; sky 天 (tiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 413
daytime 白天 (báitiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1179
De — The Hinge
chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 229
de — the particle that puts an owner in front of what is owned, and carries no tone 的 (de)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 229
decade; era 年代 (niándài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2525
Decades and Eras
chapter topic; Chapter 323, p. 2525
decent; serious and proper 正经 (zhèngjīng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3595
deflated; with the fun spoiled 扫兴 (sǎoxìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3565
delighted; to one's heart's content *tòngkuài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3565
Deliveries and the Laundry
chapter topic; Chapter 215, p. 1705
dentist 牙医 (yáyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3627
departure gate *dēngjīkǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 3199
descendants; later generations 后代 (hòudài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2539
desert *shāmò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 3359
dialect *fāngyán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 3351

diary 日记 (rìjì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 2387
dictionary *cídiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 883
difference *qūbié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 3077
different 不同 (bùtóng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1997
diligent with chores; quick to pitch in *qínkuài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3589
dim sum; light snacks and pastries 点心 (diǎnxin)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 997
dinner; supper 晚饭 (wǎnfàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 601
direction; way *fāngxiàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 2207
dirty *zāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 797
disappointed *shīwàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1969
dish of food; vegetable *cài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 359
disposable; used once *yícìxìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2965
distance *jùlí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1637
dizzy *tóuyūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3679
Do You Agree?
chapter topic; Chapter 270, p. 2093
doctor *yīshēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 685
dog *gǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 1761
Doing the Chores
chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 1319
Doing Things Together
chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 711
domestic (inside the country) *guónèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 3227
don't *bié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1261
don't; do not want 不要 (bú yào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 779

door entry system; a card-entry door *ménjìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2935
door; gate 门 (mén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 567
doorbell *ménlíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3983
doorway; entrance 门口 (ménkǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 637
down; gloomy *yùmèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 3529
dragon *lóng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2561
drawer *chōuti*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1499
Dreams
chapter topic; Chapter 512, p. 3911
drink; soft drink *yǐnliào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 869
Drinking
chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 367
driver *sījī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 685
driving licence *jiàzhào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 3235
dry air; dry (of weather or skin) *gānzào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1725
duck *yāzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 3373
duì — 'right', and on its own the commonest way to agree in spoken Mandarin 对 (duì)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 26, p. 259
dumpling *jiǎozi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 609
dusk; towards evening *bàngwǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1383
duty-free; tax-free *miǎnshuì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 3213
duty; obligation *yìwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2811

E

each other; mutually *hùxiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2907

ear *ěrduo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 467
early 早 (zǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 705
Early and Late
chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 1383
early in the morning; at daybreak *qīngchén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3963
earthquake *dìzhèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 2357
easy *róngyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1167
Easy and Important
chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 1167
Eating
chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 359
Eating Out
chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 1473
eccentric; peculiar (of a person) 古怪 (gǔguài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 540, p. 4117
eco-friendly *huánbǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2943
economy class *jīngjìcāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 3193
effect; function 作用 (zuòyòng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2873
egg *jīdàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 375
eight — first tone, and the luckiest number in the language 八 (bā)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 199
either one or the other; either ... or 要么 (yàome)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 541, p. 4123
elder brother *gēge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 313
elder brother and younger sister *xiōngmèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3881
elder sister *jiějie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 313
electrician 电工 (diàngōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 2017
electricity bill *diànfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2965

elementary; for beginners *chūjí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3791
eleven — ten one, and the teens are finished in a sentence 十一 (shíyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 213
email; mail *yóujiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1611
embarrassed 难为情 (nánwéiqíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 3529
emergency department; urgent treatment *jízhěn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3695
emotions; spirits *qíngxù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 3515
emperor *huángdì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2555
empty *kōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1099
empty seat *kòngwèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 3141
ending *jiéjú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2569
energy; sources of energy *néngyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2965
engaged; busy (of a phone line) *zhànxiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1589
engineer *gōngchéngshī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3735
English (the language) *Yīngyǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3763
enough *gòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1513
entrance; way in *rùkǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 943
envelope *xìnfēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2491
environment; surroundings *huánjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2943
era; age 时代 (shídài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2533
essay; composition (at school) 作文 (zuòwén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1959
Essays and New Characters
chapter topic; Chapter 251, p. 1959

ethnic group; nationality *mínzú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2901
even (going so far as) *shènzhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2879
even if *jíshǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 3061
even more; still more *gèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1251
evening 晚上 (wǎnshang)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 447
evening party; evening show 晚会 (wǎnhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1411
ever; (before 没) never once *cónglái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1219
Ever Since
chapter topic; Chapter 308, p. 2417
Every and Other
chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 1127
every day *měitiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 835
every; each 每 (měi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1127
every single time; always *zǒngshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1333
everyone, built from known characters 大家 (dàjiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 121
everything; all *yíqiè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 3097
everywhere *dàochù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1679
evidence; proof *zhèngjù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2433
exactly right; as it happens 正好 (zhènghǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1209
exam candidate 考生 (kǎoshēng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3777
exam hall; exam room 考场 (kǎochǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3785
Exams
chapter topic; Chapter 268, p. 2079
excited; worked up *jīdòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 2099
excuse (a poor reason) *jièkǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 3069

Excuse Me
chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 567
excuse me, may I ask 请问 (qǐngwèn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 567
excuse me; sorry to trouble you *bù hǎoyìsi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 567
exhausting; toilsome (of work) *xīnkǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3749
exit; way out 出口 (chūkǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 943
expensive *guì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 391
experience; know-how *jīngyàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 2031
expert; master (at something) 高手 (gāoshǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 2025
express delivery; courier *kuàidì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1611
expressway 高速 (gāosù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 3241
Extra Lessons
chapter topic; Chapter 493, p. 3769
extremely; very *fēicháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 663
eye *yǎnjing*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 467
eyebrow *méimao*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3619
Eyes
chapter topic; Chapter 471, p. 3611

F

face mask *kǒuzhào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1915
face; your standing in others' eyes 面子 (miànzi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2783
Faces
chapter topic; Chapter 472, p. 3619
facial expression; the look on one's face *biǎoqíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3619
fact *shìshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2723

factor *yīnsù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2873
factory *gōngchǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3727
Facts and Grounds
chapter topic; Chapter 350, p. 2723
fair; impartial 公正 (gōngzhèng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2811
fairy; heavenly maiden *xiānnǚ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2569
fairy tale *tónghuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2569
fallen leaves *luòyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3939
family members, now read and written 家人 (jiārén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 111
famous painting 名画 (mínghuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3835
famous person; well-known figure 名人 (míngrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2555
fan (of a singer) *gēmí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3867
far *yuǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 541
Far from Home
chapter topic; Chapter 343, p. 2675
fare for a ride *chēfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 3165
Farm Animals and Bugs
chapter topic; Chapter 242, p. 1897
farm stay; country guesthouse *nóngjiālè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 3373
farmer *nóngmín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1775
Fast, Far and Near
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 541
fast; quick 快 (kuài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 541
fat; plump *pàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 807
fate; destiny *mìngyùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 4035
father and daughter 父女 (fùnǚ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3873

father and son 父子 (fùzǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3873
father (the formal word) 父亲 (fùqīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3903
Fathers and Sons
chapter topic; Chapter 507, p. 3873
fault; bad habit *máobìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2857
Faults
chapter topic; Chapter 470, p. 3605
Feeling Ill
chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 1883; Chapter 240, p. 1883
Feeling Low
chapter topic; Chapter 460, p. 3529
Feeling Safe
chapter topic; Chapter 379, p. 2935
female; woman 女 (nǚ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 111
ferry *dùchuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 3171
festival 节日 (jiérì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1119
Festival Visits
chapter topic; Chapter 338, p. 2637
festive; joyous 喜庆 (xǐqìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2643
few; not much 少 (shǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 3323
filling *xiànr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2659
film; movie *diànyǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 489
final (of a competition) *juésài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3821
Finding the Way
chapter topic; Chapter 197, p. 1581
fine and happy (of a life or a future) *měihǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 536, p. 4087
finger *shǒuzhǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3635
firecrackers *biānpào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2613
firefighter *xiāofángyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 2343

fireworks *yānhuā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2643
first *dìyī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1141
first aid *jíjiù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 2351
First and Half
chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 1141
first; before anything else 先 (xiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 2085
first lunar month 正月 (zhēngyuè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2605
first of all; to begin with *shǒuxiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 2147
first prize; the jackpot *tóujiǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 4043
First, Then, Last
chapter topic; Chapter 278, p. 2147
first thing in the morning; at the crack of dawn 一大早 (yídàzǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1383
fish *yú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 1761
fishing boat *yúchuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 3419
fitting room 试衣间 (shìyījiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1673
five 五 (wǔ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 25
flight attendant; cabin crew *chéngwùyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 3193
flight; flying (of an aircraft) *fēixíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 3205
floor; storey *céng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1647
florist's; flower shop 花店 (huādiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1767
flower *huā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 593
fluent *liúlì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1241
flustered; in a panic *huāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 2365
folk song *míngē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3851

foot *jiǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 467
football; soccer *zúqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1107
For a Reason
chapter topic; Chapter 235, p. 1849
For Example
chapter topic; Chapter 281, p. 2183
for generations 世代 (shìdài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2539
for; in order to 为了 (wèile)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1849
for instance; such as 比如 (bǐrú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 2183
for many years 多年 (duōnián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2675
for sure; without doubt *kěndìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2739
for this reason; and so (written or careful speech) *yīncǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 2183
forehead *étóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3619
foreign country; abroad *wàiguó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 691
foreign currency *wàibì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 3227
foreign language 外语 (wàiyǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 927
forest *sēnlín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1781
forever *yǒngyuǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2681
fork *chāzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1391
formalities; procedure *shǒuxù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 3219
Forms
chapter topic; Chapter 455, p. 3495
Forms and Dates
chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1521
four 四 (sì)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 25
Four Seasons
chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 3931; Chapter 515, p. 3931

free (of charge) *miǎnfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1283
Free This Weekend
chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 1339
Free Time
chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 2121; Chapter 274, p. 2121
fresh *xīnxiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1439
fridge; refrigerator *bīngxiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 737
fried rice *chǎofàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1325
friend *péngyou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 329
friendly *yǒuhǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 2009
frightening; awful 可怕 (kěpà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 3549
from 从 (cóng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1271
from; away from (in distance) 离 (lí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1637
from out of town; another part of the country 外地 (wàidì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1679
From Overseas
chapter topic; Chapter 433, p. 3329
From study to university student
chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 121
from then on *cóngcǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2687
front desk; reception *qiántái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1647
fruit *shuǐguǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 375
Fruit, Bread and Eggs
chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 375
fruit juice *guǒzhī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 869
fruit tree 果树 (guǒshù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3939
fruits of work; achievements 成果 (chéngguǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 3053
full *mǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1099

full after eating; full up *bǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1439
Full Already
chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 1439
full marks *mǎnfēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3785
full name *xìngmíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 3495
full of life; vivacious *huópō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3581
full-price ticket 全票 (quánpiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 3323
full-time (of a job) 全职 (quánzhí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3741
fully booked; with no vacancies *kèmǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 3281
fun; amusing *yǒuqù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 2139
funeral *zànglǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2463
funny 好笑 (hǎoxiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 2071
furious; indignant *fènnù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 3559
furniture *jiājù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1425

G

game *yóuxì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1149
garden *huāyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1767
gè — the measure word, and the fact that a Mandarin number cannot touch a noun without one 个 (gè)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 24, p. 239
generally; as a rule; ordinary *yìbān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1333
generous; open-handed *dàfang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 2057
Gentle and Steady
chapter topic; Chapter 469, p. 3595

gentle in manner; soft-spoken 温和 (wēnhé)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3595
geography 地理 (dìlǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3763
get-together; party *jùhuì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1411
Getting About
chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 621
Getting Better
chapter topic; Chapter 483, p. 3701
Getting Engaged
chapter topic; Chapter 305, p. 2395
Getting Out
chapter topic; Chapter 301, p. 2365
Getting Ready
chapter topic; Chapter 164, p. 1347
Getting Results
chapter topic; Chapter 395, p. 3053
Getting Things Fixed
chapter topic; Chapter 208, p. 1661
Getting Washed
chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 847
ghost 鬼 (guǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2591
Ghost Stories
chapter topic; Chapter 332, p. 2591
girl 女孩 (nǚhái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 2065
Give Me That
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 761
given that; now that *jìrán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 3061
glasses; spectacles *yǎnjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1837
gloves *shǒutào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1747
go to school; attend school, built from known characters 上学 (shàngxué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 137
goalmouth; goal (in football) 球门 (qiúmén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3807
goat *shānyáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1897

Going North
chapter topic; Chapter 422, p. 3249
Going South
chapter topic; Chapter 423, p. 3257
gold medal *jīnpái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3829
Gone but Remembered
chapter topic; Chapter 325, p. 2539
good evening 晚上好 (wǎnshang hǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 447
good intentions; a kind thought 好意 (hǎoyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2761
good-looking or nice to look at 好看 (hǎokàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 171
good luck *hǎoyùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2629
Good Luck, Bad Luck
chapter topic; Chapter 529, p. 4035
good manners; politeness *lǐmào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2783
Good Morning, and a Rule That Declines to Fire
chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 67
good morning — and proof that 好 was a building block 早上好 (zǎoshang hǎo)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 67
good-natured; pleasant to deal with 和气 (héqi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3589
good night *wǎn'ān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
Good Points
chapter topic; Chapter 468, p. 3589
Good Reasons
chapter topic; Chapter 385, p. 2979
good review; favourable comment *hǎopíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 3473
good value; worth it *huásuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2987
good, well 好 (hǎo)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
goodbye — two characters whose meanings genuinely add up 再见 (zàijiàn)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 6, p. 59
government *zhèngfǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2901

gradually; little by little *jiànjiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2469
granddaughter *sūnnǚ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3897
grandma on the father's side *nǎinai*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1975
grandma on the mother's side *wàipó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3897
grandpa on the father's side *yéye*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1975
grandpa on the mother's side 外公 (wàigōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 2107
Grandparents
chapter topic; Chapter 510, p. 3897
Grandparents and Relatives
chapter topic; Chapter 253, p. 1975
grandson *sūnzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3897
grass *cǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 593
Grass and Lakes
chapter topic; Chapter 226, p. 1781
grassland; prairie *cǎoyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1781
greasy; oily *yóunì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 3449
great!; that's wonderful 太好了 (tài hǎo le)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 797
green *lǜ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1135
grey *huī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1135
Grown-Ups and Children
chapter topic; Chapter 266, p. 2065
guest 客人 (kèrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 637
guitar *jítā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 1051

H

had better; it would be best to 最好 (zuìhǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 2195

hái xíng — 'not bad', the honest middle answer between fine and tired *hái xíng*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture, reading; Chapter 30, p. 293
hair dryer *chuīfēngjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1347
hair (on the head) *tóufa*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 1023
half *bàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 439
Half Price
chapter topic; Chapter 524, p. 3997
half price 半价 (bànjià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3997
halfway; on the way 半路 (bànlù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 3265
hand 手 (shǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 467
handicraft; things made by hand 手工 (shǒugōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 2121
handsome *shuài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 1023
Happy and Sad
chapter topic; Chapter 252, p. 1969
happy; glad *gāoxìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 461
happy; in high spirits 开心 (kāixīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1969
Harbour and Deck
chapter topic; Chapter 412, p. 3179
hard lesson learned *jiàoxun*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2767
hard problem; difficult question 难题 (nántí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3785
hard seat *yìngzuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 3119
hard; stiff *yìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1099
hard-working; trying hard *nǔlì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1945
harm; downside *huàichu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2893
hat; cap *màozi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 519

have a safe journey *yílù píng'ān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1693
Have, and Count
chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 239
Have You Ever?
chapter topic; Chapter 261, p. 2031
Have You Ever Been?
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 1219
having a headache; aching in the head 头疼 (tóuténg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1795
hé — 'and' between two nouns, and never between two sentences 和 (hé)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 27, p. 269
he; him 他 (tā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 305
He, She and We
chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 305
head *tóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 467
Head, Hands and Feet
chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 467
head teacher; principal 校长 (xiàozhǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1935
Head to Knees
chapter topic; Chapter 475, p. 3643
Head to Toe
chapter topic; Chapter 230, p. 1811
Headlines
chapter topic; Chapter 293, p. 2305
health care; looking after one's health *bǎojiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3701
Healthy Habits
chapter topic; Chapter 239, p. 1877
healthy; health *jiànkāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1877
heartbeat *xīntiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3573
heavy 重 (zhòng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1099
Heavy and Soft
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 1099
Heavy Traffic
chapter topic; Chapter 409, p. 3157

height; build (of a person) 个子 (gèzi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 1023
hello (literally "you good") 你好 (nǐ hǎo)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
hello on the phone *wéi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 2505
Help Arrives
chapter topic; Chapter 299, p. 2351
help!; the cry for help *jiùmìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 2343
Helping Others
chapter topic; Chapter 375, p. 2907
hěn hǎo — 'fine', the answer to how are you, and two third tones side by side 很好 (hěn hǎo)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture, reading; Chapter 30, p. 293
hěn — 'very', and the plain link Mandarin puts in front of an adjective 很 (hěn)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 293
here 这儿 (zhèr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 503
hero *yīngxióng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2555
Heroes and Emperors
chapter topic; Chapter 327, p. 2555
high-speed railway *gāotiě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 3105
highway; main road 公路 (gōnglù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 3241
historic site *gǔjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 3309
history *lìshǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2511
Hitting the Books
chapter topic; Chapter 249, p. 1945
Hobbies
chapter topic; Chapter 250, p. 1953
hobby *àihào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1953
holiday; day off 假日 (jiàrì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2637
Holiday Plans
chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 1487
Holidays
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 1119

holidays; time off *jiàqī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1119
Home Again
chapter topic; Chapter 429, p. 3301
home cooking; everyday dishes 家常菜 (jiāchángcài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1473
home or family, now read and written 家 (jiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 111
home town; family home *lǎojiā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1487
hometown; native place *jiāxiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2667
homework *zuòyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 677
honest *chéngshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 2115
Honest and Careful
chapter topic; Chapter 273, p. 2115
honeymoon *mìyuè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2409
Hoping for More
chapter topic; Chapter 532, p. 4057
horse 马 (mǎ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 1761
hospitable 好客 (hàokè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 2115
hospital *yīyuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 405
hospital ward 病房 (bìngfáng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1889
host; owner *zhǔrén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1459
hot *rè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 461
hot and stuffy; muggy *mēnrè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1725
hot topic; what everyone is talking about 热点 (rèdiǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 2285
hotel *bīnguǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 3281
hotel guest room 客房 (kèfáng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 3273
hotel lobby *dàtáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 3273

hotel star rating *xīngjí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 3281
hour 小时 (xiǎoshí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 835
house *fángzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 503
household; a family unit *jiātíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2687
household appliance 家电 (jiādiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3971
Housework
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 1091
housework *jiāwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1091
housing estate; residential compound 小区 (xiǎoqū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2921
how absurd; curse it 见鬼 (jiànguǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2591
How Are You?
chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 293
how are you, written from three characters already yours 你好吗 (nǐ hǎo ma)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 185
How Far Is It?
chapter topic; Chapter 205, p. 1637
How Heavy?
chapter topic; Chapter 526, p. 4015
How I Feel
chapter topic; Chapter 458, p. 3515
how; in what way 怎么 (zěnme)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 2207
How It Felt
chapter topic; Chapter 286, p. 2243
How It Turned Out
chapter topic; Chapter 294, p. 2313
how long (a time) *duōjiǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 2243
how many; a few *jǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 439
how much; how many 多少 (duōshao)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 957
How Often
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 1333

how old (asking a person's age) 多大 (duō dà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 669
How People Look
chapter topic; Chapter 233, p. 1837
How You Feel
chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 461
hubby; husband (informal) 老公 (lǎogōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 2107
huge crowds; a sea of people 人山人海 (rénshānrénhǎi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 3329
humorous; witty (of a person) *yōumò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 2009
hungry *è*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 359
Husband and Wife
chapter topic; Chapter 272, p. 2107
hygiene; cleanliness *wèishēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3977

I

I'd Rather
chapter topic; Chapter 534, p. 4073
I Hope So
chapter topic; Chapter 533, p. 4065
I'm afraid that; probably *kǒngpà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 2051
I, me — one word for both, and no change for either 我 (wǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 8, p. 75
I See What You Mean
chapter topic; Chapter 367, p. 2849
ice *bīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1747
idea; way of thinking 想法 (xiǎngfǎ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2715
ideal; aspiration 理想 (lǐxiǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2729
identity card *shēnfènzhèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1521
if 要是 (yàoshi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 2263
if (closing a condition) 的话 (dehuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 2263

If I Had the Time
chapter topic; Chapter 289, p. 2273
if; in case 如果 (rúguǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 289, p. 2273
If It Rains
chapter topic; Chapter 288, p. 2263
if it were not for 要不是 (yàobúshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 541, p. 4123
If It Weren't for You
chapter topic; Chapter 541, p. 4123
If You're Willing
chapter topic; Chapter 535, p. 4079
immortal; supernatural being *shénxiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2585
important 重要 (zhòngyào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1167
impression *yìnxiàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2533
impressions afterwards; thoughts 感想 (gǎnxiǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2695
impulsive; rash *chōngdòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3595
in a low voice; quietly *xiǎoshēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2915
in an awkward spot; torn (about what to do) 为难 (wéinán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 3069
In and Out
chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 1481
In Case
chapter topic; Chapter 389, p. 3009
in case; if by any chance *wànyī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1909
in childhood; when one was little *xiǎoshíhou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 669
in front; ahead 前边 (qiánbian)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 935
In Front and Behind
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 935
in front of someone; in someone's presence 面前 (miànqián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1425
In Hospital
chapter topic; Chapter 241, p. 1889
in one's heart 心中 (xīnzhōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2675

in short; in a word *zǒngzhī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2873
in someone's lifetime; while they were alive 生前 (shēngqián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2463
In the Bathroom
chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 891
In the Cabin
chapter topic; Chapter 414, p. 3193
In the Country
chapter topic; Chapter 225, p. 1775
in the end; as a result; a result *jiéguǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1505
in the future; some day *jiānglái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1197
In the Kitchen
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 861
in the middle of (doing) 正在 (zhèngzài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1209
In the News
chapter topic; Chapter 290, p. 2285
in the past; to go over (there) 过去 (guòqù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1219
In the Shop
chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 391
in time; promptly; before it was too late *jíshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 2351
incident; event (in the news) *shìjiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 2291
income *shōurù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2995
incoming call 来电 (láidiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2497
indeed; it is true that *quèshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2723
individuality; a strong personality 个性 (gèxìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3581
Injuries
chapter topic; Chapter 478, p. 3663
inn; small hotel 旅店 (lǚdiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 3281
insect; bug *chóngzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1897
inside; in *lǐbian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 719

inside; in 里 (lǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 691
Inside the Body
chapter topic; Chapter 477, p. 3657
insight; considered view 见解 (jiànjiě)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2849
insurance *bǎoxiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 4109
intention; the purpose behind it 用意 (yòngyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2887
interest; interest in something *xìngqù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1953
interesting *yǒuyìsi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 1059
intermediate (in level) 中级 (zhōngjí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3791
international *guójì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 3227
is it good, written from three characters already yours and no new shape at all 好不好 (hǎo bu hǎo)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 185
Is It Serious?
chapter topic; Chapter 481, p. 3687
is not — and a pitch that moves to get out of the way 不是 (bú shì)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 5, p. 51
is that so, written from two characters already yours 是吗 (shì ma)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 185
Is There Any?
chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 737
island 岛 (dǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 3411
It Depends
chapter topic; Chapter 398, p. 3077
it doesn't matter; never mind *méi guānxi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1717
it is said that; reportedly *jùshuō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2687
it is thanks to; luckily for *duōkuī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 541, p. 4123
it may be that; perhaps *yěxǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1997

It Might Rain
chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 1187
it's nothing; to be all right 没事 (méishì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1369
it's time to; should (by now) 该 (gāi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 2195
it seems; it looks as if 看来 (kànlai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1997
it serves them right; serves you right 活该 (huógāi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2447
itinerary; plan for a trip *xíngchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 3295
itself (in itself) 本身 (běnshēn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 538, p. 4103

J

Jobs
chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 685
Jobs Around the House
chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 1419
joke 笑话 (xiàohua)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 2071
journalist; reporter *jìzhě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 2017
journey *lǚtú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 3301
joyful; happy 快乐 (kuàilè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 647

K

Keep Going
chapter topic; Chapter 368, p. 2857
Keeping a Pet
chapter topic; Chapter 229, p. 1803
Keeping Calm
chapter topic; Chapter 466, p. 3573
Keeping Fit
chapter topic; Chapter 220, p. 1741
Keeping House
chapter topic; Chapter 521, p. 3977

Keeping It Clean
chapter topic; Chapter 443, p. 3403
Keeping Memories
chapter topic; Chapter 344, p. 2681
key *yàoshi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 737
key; crucial point *guānjiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2873
kilogram *gōngjīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 4015
kilometre 公里 (gōnglǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1637
kind-hearted *shànliáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3589
kind thoughts; a token of regard 心意 (xīnyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2629
kindergarten; nursery school *yòu'éryuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 2381
king 国王 (guówáng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2577
kingdom 王国 (wángguó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2577
kitchen *chúfáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 861
knee *xīgài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3643
knife *dāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 861
knowledge *zhīshi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3799

L

label; luggage tag *biāoqiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 3481
ladder *tīzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1419
lake *hú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1781
lamp; light *dēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 737
landlord; landlady 房东 (fángdōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1623

lane; alley (in an old city) *hútòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 3425
Language or country?
chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 159
lantern *dēnglóng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2613
Lanterns and Riddles
chapter topic; Chapter 335, p. 2613
last bus or train *mòbānchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 3127
last; finally; in the end 最后 (zuìhòu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 2147
last month 上个月 (shàng ge yuè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1197
Late Again
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 1173
late at night; the dead of night *shēnyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1383
lately; recently *zuìjìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1445
Laundry Day
chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 1453
laundry shop 洗衣店 (xǐyīdiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1705
law and order; public order *zhì'ān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2935
law; the law *fǎlǜ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2915
lawn; grassy ground 草地 (cǎodì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1781
lawyer *lǜshī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 2017
le after a verb: the event is finished — and this is aspect, not tense 了 (le)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 25, p. 249
Le — Finished, and Changed
chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 249
lead story; headline; the front-page story *tóutiáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 2305
leaf *yèzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1865
Learning
chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 483

Learning on Your Own
chapter topic; Chapter 497, p. 3799
leg *tuǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1811
legend; folk tale 传说 (chuánshuō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2561
lèi — 'tired', and asked with 吗 **like any other statement** *lèi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 293
lesson; class *kè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 483
let us hope that; if only 但愿 (dànyuàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 535, p. 4079
letter (in the post) *xìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 983
Letters from Far Away
chapter topic; Chapter 318, p. 2491
Levels
chapter topic; Chapter 496, p. 3791
library *túshūguǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 855
Life and Death
chapter topic; Chapter 300, p. 2357
life; daily life *shēnghuó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1983
life jacket 救生衣 (jiùshēngyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 3171
lift; elevator *diàntī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1545
light and mild (of food) *qīngdàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 3449
light bulb *dēngpào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1419
light from the sun or a lamp 光 (guāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3947
Light in the Dark
chapter topic; Chapter 517, p. 3947
lighthouse *dēngtǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 3411
lightning *shǎndiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3925
like this; this way *zhèyàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 1043
Likes and Dislikes
chapter topic; Chapter 277, p. 2139

line of business; industry *hángyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3727
listeners; the people listening to the radio *tīngzhòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 2299
lively; bustling *rènao*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 1059
living room; sitting room *kètīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1311
local 本地 (běndì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1679
local flavour; distinctive taste 风味 (fēngwèi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 3449
Local Food
chapter topic; Chapter 450, p. 3457
Local or From Out of Town
chapter topic; Chapter 211, p. 1679
local police station *pàichūsuǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2417
Locked Up
chapter topic; Chapter 312, p. 2447
lonely; on one's own *gūdān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 3521
long 长 (cháng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 533
Long Ago and Soon
chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1493
Long and Short
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 533
long-distance *chángtú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 3165
long holiday 长假 (chángjià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2643
Long Trips
chapter topic; Chapter 410, p. 3165
Looking and reading
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 171
Looking Back
chapter topic; Chapter 317, p. 2687; Chapter 345, p. 2687
Looking for Work
chapter topic; Chapter 486, p. 3721
loose; baggy (of clothes) *féi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1597
Losing My Temper
chapter topic; Chapter 464, p. 3559

Lost and Found
chapter topic; Chapter 456, p. 3501
Lost on the Way
chapter topic; Chapter 285, p. 2231
lottery ticket *cǎipiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 4043
loudly; in a loud voice *dàshēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2811
Love and Kindness
chapter topic; Chapter 461, p. 3535
luckily; fortunately *xìnghǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1857
lucky by a fluke *jiǎoxìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 4049
lucky; fortunate *xìngyùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 4035
luggage *xíngli*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 989
luggage case; a travel case *xínglixiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 3481
luggage rack *xínglijià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 3135
lunar New Year's Eve *Chúxī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2599
lunch 午饭 (wǔfàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 601

M

mā má mǎ mà — one syllable, four words
pronunciation topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
magazine *zázhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 2305
magic *mófǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2585
magnificent; spectacular *zhuàngguān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 3343
main; chief *zhǔyào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 541, p. 4123
major; field of study *zhuānyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3763
Making a Date
chapter topic; Chapter 388, p. 3001

Making It Clear
chapter topic; Chapter 369, p. 2865
male 男 (nán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 321
man 男人 (nánrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 321
manager *jīnglǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 2043
máng — 'busy', an adjective, so it takes 很 like 好 *máng*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 293
many; much; a lot of 多 (duō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 3315
many thanks; thanks a lot 多谢 (duōxiè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 3507
map *dìtú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1679
market; marketplace 市场 (shìchǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 3441
market stall *tānwèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 3441
Marks
chapter topic; Chapter 495, p. 3785
marriage; the bond of marriage *hūnyīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2687
married couple; husband and wife *fūqī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3873
Marrying and Parting
chapter topic; Chapter 307, p. 2409
match; competition *bǐsài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1107
Match Day
chapter topic; Chapter 500, p. 3821
maths; mathematics *shùxué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3763
matter; affair 事情 (shìqing)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 3521
may all go as you wish 万事如意 (wànshì rúyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 534, p. 4073
may; can (with permission) *kěyǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 2025
may I trouble you (asking a favour) *láojià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 3507
may your wishes all come true 心想事成 (xīnxiǎng shìchéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 533, p. 4065

maybe; possibly *kěnéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1187
Me Too
chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 787
Meals
chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 601
meaning; what something means 意思 (yìsi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2701
measure word for a rainstorm; measure word for a game or a show 场 (chǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 3205
measure word for a serving; portion *fèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1325
measure word for essays and stories *piān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1959
measure word for long things (skirts, scarves, trousers, fish, roads) *tiáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1353
measure word for rooms 间 (jiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1465
meat *ròu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 609
meatless dish; vegetable dish *sùcài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 3465
medical check-up *tǐjiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1877
member of staff; employee (of a firm or factory) 职工 (zhígōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3741
memory *jìyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2681
menu *càidān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 787
messy; in a mess *luàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2811
microwave oven *wēibōlú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1391
Mid-Autumn
chapter topic; Chapter 342, p. 2667
middle age 中年 (zhōngnián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 2065
middle school, built from known characters 中学 (zhōngxué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 137

middle-school student, built from known characters 中学生 (zhōngxuésheng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 137
mild like spring all year round (of a place) 四季如春 (sìjì rú chūn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3963
milk *niúnǎi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 367
mindset; attitude of mind *xīntài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3713
minute (a length of time) *fēnzhōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1161
minute; to divide *fēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 439
mirror *jìngzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 891
miserable; unwell *nánshòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1755
misfortune; unfortunate *búxìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 4049
mishap; something unexpected 意外 (yìwài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 2329
mistake; error *cuòwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2767
mobile phone 手机 (shǒujī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 511
modern times; modern 现代 (xiàndài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2525
modest *qiānxū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2783
Monday 星期一 (xīngqīyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 421
money *qián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 957
Money In, Money Out
chapter topic; Chapter 387, p. 2995
Money to Spend
chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1513
monkey *hóuzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1761
monster; demon *yāoguài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2585
Monsters and Treasure
chapter topic; Chapter 331, p. 2585

month; moon *yuè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 429
Months and Years
chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 429
mood; frame of mind *xīnqíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1915
Moods
chapter topic; Chapter 271, p. 2099
mooncake 月饼 (yuèbǐng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2659
Mooncakes
chapter topic; Chapter 341, p. 2659
moonlight *yuèguāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2675
morality; ethics *dàodé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2791
More Housework
chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 1155
more often than not; tends to *wǎngwǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1493
more than usual; unusually 格外 (géwài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 4005
More to Eat
chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 609
morning — and a syllable with no tone at all 早上 (zǎoshang)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 67
morning and evening; sooner or later 早晚 (zǎowǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1493
morning (before noon) 上午 (shàngwǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 447
morning market; a market held at dawn 早市 (zǎoshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 3441
mosquito *wénzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1897
most *zuì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1141
most likely; eighty per cent 八成 (bāchéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2979
mother and daughter 母女 (mǔnǚ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3889
mother (the formal word) 母亲 (mǔqīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3903
mother tongue 母语 (mǔyǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3889

motor vehicle; car *qìchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 3135
mountain area 山区 (shānqū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 3359
mountain; hill 山 (shān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 593
mountain village 山村 (shāncūn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 3379
Mountains and Plains
chapter topic; Chapter 437, p. 3359
mouth 口 (kǒu)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 41
mouth; beak *zuǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3627
Moving House
chapter topic; Chapter 313, p. 2455
Moving On
chapter topic; Chapter 428, p. 3295
Moving the Dates
chapter topic; Chapter 400, p. 3091
Mr; sir; husband *xiānsheng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 337
Mum and Dad
chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 313
mum; mother 妈妈 (māma)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 313
museum *bówùguǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1529
Music
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 1051
music 音乐 (yīnyuè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 1051
Music and Shows
chapter topic; Chapter 257, p. 2003
Music on Stage
chapter topic; Chapter 506, p. 3867
musical instrument *yuèqì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 2003
must; it is required that 必须 (bìxū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2811
My Day in Characters
chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 835
My own line — the first Chinese with no model
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 97, p. 835

myth *shénhuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2561

N

naive; innocent 天真 (tiānzhēn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2893
name — literally the characters a name is made of 名字 (míngzi)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 75
national anthem 国歌 (guógē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3851
National Day
chapter topic; Chapter 339, p. 2643
National Day 国庆 (Guóqìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2643
natural; made by nature 天然 (tiānrán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 3387
natural resources *zīyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2971
naturally; nature 自然 (zìrán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2477
nature reserve; protected area 保护区 (bǎohùqū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 3403
Ne and Dui
chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 259
ne — the particle that hands the question back, and turns one word into a whole turn 呢 (ne)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 26, p. 259
near; close *jìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 541
nearby; in the area *fùjìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 935
nearly; almost *chàdiǎnr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1857
neat; orderly *zhěngqí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3977
necessary 必要 (bìyào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2797
neck *bózi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3651
Neck and Shoulders
chapter topic; Chapter 476, p. 3651

need not; there's no need to 不必 (búbì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2797
neighbour *línjū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1433
nervous; tense *jǐnzhāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 2057
Never Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 217, p. 1717
new *xīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 533
new character; a character not yet learned 生字 (shēngzì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1959
new student 新生 (xīnshēng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 2381
New Year's Eve
chapter topic; Chapter 333, p. 2599
New Year's Eve dinner *niányèfàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2599
newborn; infant *yīng'ér*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 2373
news; a message *xiāoxi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1293
newspaper; the daily paper 报 (bào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 2305
next door *gébì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 3287
Next Month
chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 1197
next month 下个月 (xià ge yuè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1197
next; straight after that *jiēzhe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 2147
next time *xià cì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1339
next to the window *kàochuāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 3193
next week 下星期 (xià xīngqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1197
next year 明年 (míngnián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 429
Nǐ Hǎo — Hello, Character by Character
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1
ní hǎo — why the greeting is not said the way it is written
pronunciation topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 1, p. 1

nice to drink 好喝 (hǎohē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 3449
night market *yèshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 3449
night shift *yèbān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3749
nightmare *èmèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 3549
nine — third tone, and a dip you have had since ni 九 (jiǔ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 199
no matter what; whatever anyone says 死活 (sǐhuó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2447
no matter (whether or how) *bùguǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 3061
No Need
chapter topic; Chapter 360, p. 2797
no wonder *guàibude*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1849
Noise Next Door
chapter topic; Chapter 378, p. 2929
noisy 吵 (chǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 1059
noodles *miàntiáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 609
noon 中午 (zhōngwǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 447
normal; as usual 正常 (zhèngcháng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1445
normally; usually *tōngcháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1333
North and South
chapter topic; Chapter 436, p. 3351
north and south 南北 (nánběi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 3257
northeast; the Northeast (of China) 东北 (dōngběi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 3249
northern part 北部 (běibù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 3365
northwest; the Northwest (of China) 西北 (xīběi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 3249
nose *bízi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1811
Not Allowed
chapter topic; Chapter 364, p. 2827

not bad; pretty good *búcuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1241
not have; there is no 没有 (méiyǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 737
not in the least; (not) at all *gēnběn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 538, p. 4103
not necessarily 不见得 (bújiànde)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2745
not — the character that turns a word around 不 (bù)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 41
notebook 本子 (běnzi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 883
notes (taken in class) *bǐjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3799
novel; story (in a book) 小说 (xiǎoshuō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1953
novice; beginner 新手 (xīnshǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 2329
now *xiànzài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 413
now and then; occasionally *ǒu'ěr*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1333
number (of a phone, a room); identifying number *hàomǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 2505
nurse *hùshi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1821
nursery rhyme; children's song 儿歌 (érgē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3851
nutrition; nourishment *yíngyǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3701

O

o'clock; dot 点 (diǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 439
occasion; setting *chǎnghé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2797
occupation; profession *zhíyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 2017
Odds and Ends
chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1499
of course *dāngrán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1717

of one's own free will; voluntary 自愿 (zìyuàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 535, p. 4079
of that place; in the place in question 当地 (dāngdì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2477
off season; quiet season *dànjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 3323
office *bàngōngshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1647
official receipt 发票 (fāpiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 3295
often *chángcháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 1035
Often and Sometimes
chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 1035
oh no; what a mess *zāogāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1711
oil painting *yóuhuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3835
old *lǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 337
old (of things); no longer new *jiù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 541
Old Ways
chapter topic; Chapter 340, p. 2651
Older Than Me
chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 1251
on earth (in a question) *dàodǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2887
On Foot
chapter topic; Chapter 447, p. 3433
On My Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 459, p. 3521
on one's way *shùnlù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 3301
on purpose; deliberately 故意 (gùyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2425
on schedule (of a train or plane) 正点 (zhèngdiǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 3111
On the Desk
chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 883
On the Expressway
chapter topic; Chapter 421, p. 3241
On the Move
chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 905

On the Phone
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 2505; Chapter 320, p. 2505
On the Pitch
chapter topic; Chapter 498, p. 3807
On the Radio
chapter topic; Chapter 292, p. 2299
On the Road
chapter topic; Chapter 424, p. 3265
on the spot; there and then *dāngchǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 2319
On the Staff
chapter topic; Chapter 489, p. 3741
On the Water
chapter topic; Chapter 411, p. 3171
on time; punctual *zhǔnshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1161
on top; above *shàngbian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 727
on your person; on one's body 身上 (shēnshang)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1811
Once Again
chapter topic; Chapter 315, p. 2469
once (in the past); at one time *céngjīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 2031
Once upon a Time
chapter topic; Chapter 329, p. 2569
once upon a time; in the past 从前 (cóngqián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1445
one 一 (yī)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 25
One Box, Two Characters, and the First Thing You Can Refuse
chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 41
One Character, Two Courtesies
chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 93
one half; half (of something) 一半 (yíbàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1141
One reason — a line of your own with 因为 and 所以
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 281, p. 2183
one's close family; one's nearest and dearest 亲人 (qīnrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3903
one's early years; long ago 早年 (zǎonián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2519
one's elders; the older generation *zhǎngbèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3873

one's later years; old age 晚年 (wǎnnián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2519
one's nature; an inborn trait 天性 (tiānxìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3581
one's own (by birth) 亲生 (qīnshēng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3903
one's superior at work 上司 (shàngsi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3755
one's taste in food 口味 (kǒuwèi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 3449
One small step into school
chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 131
One Thing Leads to Another
chapter topic; Chapter 538, p. 4103
One to Five — Where the Character Is the Count
chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 25
one way (of a ticket or a trip) *dānchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 2219
oneself *zìjǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1127
Online
chapter topic; Chapter 204, p. 1631
online friend *wǎngyǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2687
only child *dúshēngzǐnǚ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3881
Only If
chapter topic; Chapter 399, p. 3083
only if (with cái after it) 只有 (zhǐyǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 3083
only then; not until 才 (cái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2455
Opening Hours
chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 1009
opponent; rival 对手 (duìshǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 2037
opposite; across from *duìmiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 699
optimistic *lèguān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3565
or (in a question) 还是 (háishi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1261
or (in a statement) *huòzhě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1261

oral exam 口试 (kǒushì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 2079
orchard *guǒyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 3373
Ordering Online
chapter topic; Chapter 527, p. 4023
origin *qǐyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2687
originally; at first 本来 (běnlái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 2085
originally planned *yuándìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 3091
osmanthus flowers *guìhuā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2667
other people *biérén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1127
other; the others *qítā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 1127
otherwise; or else 不然 (bùrán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 289, p. 2273
Our Neighbourhood
chapter topic; Chapter 377, p. 2921
Out in Nature
chapter topic; Chapter 519, p. 3963
Out in Public
chapter topic; Chapter 363, p. 2915; Chapter 376, p. 2915
Out in the Hills
chapter topic; Chapter 246, p. 1921
Out in the Open
chapter topic; Chapter 441, p. 3387
Out of Town
chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 593
outside *wàibian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 719
outside class; extracurricular 课外 (kèwài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3799
outstanding; excellent 出色 (chūsè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 3465
overcast day *yīntiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1113
overcoat; coat 大衣 (dàyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1353
overseas; beyond the sea 海外 (hǎiwài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 3329

overseas Chinese; a Chinese person settled abroad *huáqiáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 3329
overweight; over the weight limit *chāozhòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 3219
owing to; because of *yóuyú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1849
Owning Up
chapter topic; Chapter 357, p. 2775

P

pain; ache *téngtòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3651
painter (an artist) 画家 (huàjiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3835
Painting
chapter topic; Chapter 502, p. 3835
paper *zhǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 883
paper napkin *cānjīnzhǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 3473
papers; an identity document *zhèngjiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 2231
parcel; package *bāoguǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 983
Parents
chapter topic; Chapter 509, p. 3889
parents; one's mother and father 父母 (fùmǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3889
park *gōngyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 855
Parking
chapter topic; Chapter 420, p. 3235
parking space *chēwèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 3235
part; section (of a whole) *bùfen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 3365
Parting
chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 655
passenger *chéngkè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 3105
passenger ship 客船 (kèchuán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 3179

passer-by; stranger in the street 路人 (lùrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 3501
passport *hùzhào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 971
password; PIN *mìmǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1567
past events; things of the past *wǎngshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2681
patient; sick person 病人 (bìngrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 1883
patient with people *nàixīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 2009
pavement; sidewalk *rénxíngdào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 3433
pay and conditions (of a job) *dàiyù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3721
pay; wages *gōngzī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1989
Paying
chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 957; Chapter 114, p. 957
peak (of traffic); rush hour *gāofēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 3157
peak season; busy season *wàngjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 3309
peanut 花生 (huāshēng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1865
pedestrian street; a street closed to cars *bùxíngjiē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 3433
pen *bǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 883
pen pal *bǐyǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2491
pencil *qiānbǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 883
peninsula 半岛 (bàndǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 3411
People and Government
chapter topic; Chapter 374, p. 2901
People of Long Ago
chapter topic; Chapter 321, p. 2511
People under one roof
chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 111
perhaps; who knows *shuōbudìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1909

period (during which); during 期间 (qījiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2667
period; phase 时期 (shíqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2525
person 人 (rén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 111
personality; character *xìnggé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 2009
personally (doing it oneself) 亲自 (qīnzì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3903
pessimistic *bēiguān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3565
pet *chǒngwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1803
petty; narrow-minded 小心眼 (xiǎoxīnyǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3611
phone charges *huàfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2497
phone signal *xìnhào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1589
Phones and Messages
chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1589
photo album *xiàngcè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2681
photo; photograph *zhàopiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 919
physical education (a school subject) *tǐyù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3807
physical strength 力气 (lìqi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3635
piano *gāngqín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 927
pier; wharf *mǎtou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 3171
pig *zhū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1897
pillow *zhěntou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1465
pink *fěnhóng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1135
place *dìfang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 691
place; venue 地点 (dìdiǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1653

Places in Town
chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 405
plain; flat open land *píngyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 3359
plan *jìhuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1653
plane's captain; pilot in command 机长 (jīzhǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 3185
plane ticket 机票 (jīpiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1573
Plans for the Future
chapter topic; Chapter 401, p. 3097
plant *zhíwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1865
Plants
chapter topic; Chapter 237, p. 1865
plastic bag *sùliàodài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1499
plate; dish *pánzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 861
plateau; highland *gāoyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 3359
pleasant; cheerful *yúkuài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1927
pleasant surprise *jīngxǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 3543
pleasant to hear *hǎotīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 1051
pleasantly cool *liángkuai*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1113
pleasantly warm; mild *nuǎnhuo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1725
please — a word you can say on its own, and a frame waiting to be filled 请 (qǐng)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 103
pleasure boat 游船 (yóuchuán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 3315
point of view; standpoint *guāndiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2695
police car 警车 (jǐngchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2439
police officer; the police *jǐngchá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1711

pond *chítáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1921
poor (having little money) *qióng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2907
popular; all the rage 热门 (rèmén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 2121
population 人口 (rénkǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2901
port; harbour *gǎngkǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 3179
Post and Parcels
chapter topic; Chapter 201, p. 1611
post office *yóujú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 855
postage stamp *yóupiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1611
postcard *míngxìnpiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2491
postcode *yóubiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2687
pot; pan; wok *guō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1391
Pots and Pans
chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 1391
power socket *chāzuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 3281
present; gift *lǐwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 647
presenter; host of a show *zhǔchírén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 2285
Pressure at Work
chapter topic; Chapter 490, p. 3749
pressure; stress *yālì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3713
pretty; good-looking *piàoliang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 519
price *jiàqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1283
Price List
chapter topic; Chapter 156, p. 1283
prices; the cost of living *wùjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3997
Prices Up and Down
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1551

primary school, built from known characters 小学 (xiǎoxué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 14, p. 131

primary-school student, built from known characters 小学生 (xiǎoxuésheng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 14, p. 131

prince 王子 (wángzǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2577

princess *gōngzhǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2569

principle *yuánzé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2879

prison *jiānyù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2447

private tutor 家教 (jiājiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3769

production cost; cost 成本 (chéngběn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2971

programme; TV show *jiémù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 2071

pronunciation; how a character is read 读音 (dúyīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1945

property management; the management office *wùyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2929

Pros and Cons
chapter topic; Chapter 373, p. 2893

prospects; future (of a person or job) *qiántú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 3097

prosperous; flourishing 红火 (hónghuǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2605

proud; full of oneself *jiāo'ào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3605

public holiday 节假日 (jiéjiàrì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 3323

public; shared by everyone *gōnggòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2797

public square *guǎngchǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1559

public transport 公交 (gōngjiāo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 3149

Pulling In
chapter topic; Chapter 407, p. 3141

pupil's parent; parent of a schoolchild 家长 (jiāzhǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1935

purple *zǐsè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1673
Putting two pieces together — and reading the result
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 11

Q

quality *zhìliàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1551
queen (a king's wife) 王后 (wánghòu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2577
question; problem *wèntí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1699
quickly; hurry *gǎnkuài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1173
quiet *ānjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 1059
Quiet and Noisy
chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 1059
quilt; duvet *bèizi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1465

R

rabbit; hare *tùzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1761
radio station *diàntái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 2285
railway carriage *chēxiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 3105
railway station *huǒchēzhàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 3105
rain 雨 (yǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 577
Rain or Shine
chapter topic; Chapter 234, p. 1843
rainbow *cǎihóng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1871
raincoat 雨衣 (yǔyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1843
rainy season 雨季 (yǔjì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3931

rapid; high-speed 快速 (kuàisù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 3249
rare; hard to come by 难得 (nándé)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 3069
Reading — Characters, Words, and a First Passage
chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 289
Reading the Greeting — One Piece at a Time
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 11
ready-made 现成 (xiànchéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 3077
real; genuine 真正 (zhēnzhèng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2783
Real Manners
chapter topic; Chapter 358, p. 2783
really; truly *zhēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 663
reason; cause *yuányīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1173
reason; grounds *lǐyóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1849
reasonable; in the right 有理 (yǒulǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2729
receipt *shōujù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1617
red *hóng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 525
red envelope 红包 (hóngbāo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2605
Red Envelopes
chapter topic; Chapter 334, p. 2605
region; area (of a country) 地区 (dìqū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 3077
regularly; often *jīngcháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1333
relative; family member *qīnqi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1975
relaxed; light and easy *qīngsōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 3515
Remembering
chapter topic; Chapter 324, p. 2533
remote control *yáokòngqì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1399
rent for a home *fángzū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1623

Renting a Flat
chapter topic; Chapter 203, p. 1623
reply; echo 回音 (huíyīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2491
resident (of a place) *jūmín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2921
resistance to illness *dǐkànglì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3707
responsibility; blame *zérèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 4109
restaurant *fàndiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 405
restaurant *fànguǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1473
results; marks *chéngjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1945
return journey; the journey back *huíchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 3295
Rice and Meat
chapter topic; Chapter 161, p. 1325
rice paddy; paddy field *dàotián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 3373
rich; well-off 有钱 (yǒuqián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1513
riddle *míyǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2613
ridiculous; laughable 可笑 (kěxiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2849
Right Now
chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 1209
right; suitable; a good fit *héshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 911
risk *fēngxiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 3009
river 河 (hé)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 3395
road; a street for traffic 马路 (mǎlù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1559
road conditions *lùkuàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 3257
road sign *lùbiāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 3265
road; way *lù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 621

Roads and Crossings
chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1559
romantic love; love between a couple 爱情 (àiqíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 3535
room *fángjiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 503
room key card *fángkǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 3273
room with a double bed *dàchuángfáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 3281
Rooms at Home
chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 1311
round *yuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1135
round trip 来回 (láihuí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 3135
route *lùxiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1581
rubbish *lājī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1155
rubbish bin *lājītǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1499
rule; regulation *guīdìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1667
Rules
chapter topic; Chapter 359, p. 2791
Rules and Notices
chapter topic; Chapter 209, p. 1667
rules of a game; set procedure *guīzé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2791
rules of conduct; manners *guījù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2651
Running Late
chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 705

S

sad; heartbroken *shāngxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1969
sad; upset *nánguò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 1029
safe; safety *ānquán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1667

salty *xián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 3449
Same Here
chapter topic; Chapter 352, p. 2739
sandy beach *shātān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1789
satisfied; pleased *mǎnyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1969
Saving Energy
chapter topic; Chapter 383, p. 2965
savings (in the bank) *cúnkuǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2995
Saying Goodbye
chapter topic; Chapter 314, p. 2463
Saying Sorry
chapter topic; Chapter 275, p. 2127
Saying Who You Are
chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 75
scar *shāngbā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3671
Scared
chapter topic; Chapter 463, p. 3549
scarf *wéijīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1353
scary; giving people a fright *xiàrén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 3549
scenery; landscape *fēngjǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1781
scenic area *jǐngqū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 3309
scheduled flight *hángbān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1573
school *xuéxiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 397
School Subjects
chapter topic; Chapter 492, p. 3763
school term; semester 学期 (xuéqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1935
schoolbag 书包 (shūbāo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 989
scientist *kēxuéjiā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3735
scissors *jiǎndāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1499

Screens
chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 919
script; written language 文字 (wénzì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2511
Sea and Sky
chapter topic; Chapter 238, p. 1871
sea wave; a wave of the sea *hǎilàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 3419
seafood *hǎixiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 3457
seashell *bèiké*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 3419
season *jìjié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 3931
seat belt *ānquándài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 3193
Second-Hand
chapter topic; Chapter 386, p. 2987
second-hand 二手 (èrshǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2987
second (of time) *miǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1161
secondly; second in order *qícì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2865
secretary *mìshū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3755
security camera; CCTV *jiānkòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2957
security check 安检 (ānjiǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 3199
security guard 保安 (bǎo'ān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2957
See You Again
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 59
see you tomorrow 明天见 (míngtiān jiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
Seeing a Doctor
chapter topic; Chapter 231, p. 1821
Seeing Friends Off
chapter topic; Chapter 336, p. 2621
Seeing the Sights
chapter topic; Chapter 430, p. 3309
Seen and Understood
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 1229

self-confident; sure of oneself 自信 (zìxìn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3565
selfish *zìsī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3605
seller 卖家 (màijiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3989
Sending Things
chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 983
senior high school 高中 (gāozhōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1935
sense; the reason something makes sense 道理 (dàoli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2745
sensible; grown-up for one's age (of a child) *dǒngshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3881
serious injury; badly hurt 重伤 (zhòngshāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3663
serious (of illness); serious (of a problem) *yánzhòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1795
service desk; information desk *fúwùtái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 3487
Services in Town
chapter topic; Chapter 212, p. 1687
settled; stable 安定 (āndìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 3091
seven — first tone, and a consonant English does not have 七 (qī)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 199
she; her *tā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 305
ship's cabin *chuáncāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 3179
ship's captain 船长 (chuánzhǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 3171
ship's deck *jiǎbǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 3179
shoe *xié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 519
shop *shāngdiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 391
shop assistant *shòuhuòyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 4005
shopping centre *shāngchǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1529
Shops in Town
chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1529

short in height; low *ǎi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 533
short in length; brief *duǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 533
short-sighted *jìnshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3611
should; ought to 应该 (yīnggāi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 2195
shoulder *jiānbǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3651
shy; bashful *hàixiū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 2057
Shy or Brave
chapter topic; Chapter 265, p. 2057
sick leave 病假 (bìngjià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 2043
side; beside *pángbiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 691
sight; place of interest *jǐngdiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1653
significance; meaning *yìyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2701
Signs in a Building
chapter topic; Chapter 192, p. 1545
simple *jiǎndān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1167
simultaneously; at the same moment 同时 (tóngshí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2887
since childhood; since I was little 从小 (cóngxiǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 2085
since; ever since 自从 (zìcóng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2417
sincere; from the bottom of your heart 真心 (zhēnxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2783
singer *gēshǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 2003
single room *dānrénjiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 3281
sisters *jiěmèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3881
situation; how things stand *qíngkuàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 2313
Six lines to a friend, a story with advice at the end
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 289, p. 2273

six — the sixth number, and the first one past where this book stopped 六 (liù)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 199
Six to Ten, and the Character That Was Already Here
chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 199
size 大小 (dàxiǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 911
Sizes
chapter topic; Chapter 199, p. 1597
skill; technique *jìshù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 2025
skill; what someone is capable of 本事 (běnshi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 2025
skilled tradesman; master (and how you address one) *shīfu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1661
skin *pífū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1837
skirt *qúnzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1353
Sleeping and Waking
chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 455
sleeping berth *wòpù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 3119
slim; slender *miáotiao*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1837
sloppy; slapdash *mǎhu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3605
slow *màn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 475
slow-witted; clumsy *bèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3605
small change; loose coins *língqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1513
small; little, now read and written 小 (xiǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 14, p. 131
smelling good; fragrant; tasty *xiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1405
smooth; without a hitch *shùnlì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 3039
snack; street food 小吃 (xiǎochī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1473
snake *shé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1897

snow *xuě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 577
Snow and Ice
chapter topic; Chapter 221, p. 1747
snowflake 雪花 (xuěhuā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1903
snowman 雪人 (xuěrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1747
so; and then (as a result) *yúshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 2313
so as not to; lest *miǎnde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 538, p. 4103
so as to guard against; as a precaution *yǐfáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 3009
so (it turns out); as it turns out 原来 (yuánlái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 537, p. 4095
so; that (much) 那么 (nàme)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1251
So That's Why
chapter topic; Chapter 540, p. 4117
so; therefore *suǒyǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 827
so; this much; like this 这么 (zhème)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 2173
soap *féizào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 891
social worker 社工 (shègōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2915
society 社会 (shèhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2907
sofa *shāfā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1425
Sofa and Shelves
chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 1425
soft *ruǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 1099
soft sleeper *ruǎnwò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 3141
solar energy; solar power 太阳能 (tàiyángnéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3955
solar term 节气 (jiéqì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2651
some; a few 一些 (yìxiē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 1043

some other day; another time *gǎitiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1843
something else; other *biéde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 787
Something Has Gone Wrong
chapter topic; Chapter 216, p. 1711
Something Needs Fixing
chapter topic; Chapter 522, p. 3983
Something New
chapter topic; Chapter 291, p. 2291
Something Odd
chapter topic; Chapter 236, p. 1857
something on your mind; a worry 心事 (xīnshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 2099
something said in anger 气话 (qìhuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2775
Something to Drink
chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 869
something to look forward to *pàntou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 536, p. 4087
sometimes *yǒushíhou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 1035
son, now read and written 儿子 (érzi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 111
song *gē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 1051
Songs
chapter topic; Chapter 504, p. 3851
sons and daughters; children 子女 (zǐnǚ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1975
sore; painful *téng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 1883
sorry 对不起 (duìbuqǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 1699
Sorry, I Can't
chapter topic; Chapter 264, p. 2051
sorry; regretful *bàoqiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 2051
sound; voice; noise *shēngyīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1369
soundproofing; soundproof *géyīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2929
soup *tāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 609

sour *suān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1405
southeast 东南 (dōngnán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 3257
southwest; the Southwest (of China) 西南 (xīnán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 3257
souvenir *jìniànpǐn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1927
spare (kept for when needed) *bèiyòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 3009
Speaking and Hearing
chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 475
special character; speciality 特色 (tèsè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 3465
special; especially *tèbié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1167
special offer; reduced price *tèjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1551
Specialities
chapter topic; Chapter 451, p. 3465
specially; for that very purpose 特意 (tèyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 3457
speed of a vehicle 车速 (chēsù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 3241
speed per hour 时速 (shísù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 3265
spicy; hot *là*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 3449
Spoiling the Fun
chapter topic; Chapter 465, p. 3565
spoon; ladle *sháozi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1391
Sport
chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 1107
sport; exercise *yùndòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 2121
sports fan *qiúmí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 2121
sports ground; pitch; court 球场 (qiúchǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3807
spring 春天 (chūntiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 3931
Spring Festival couplets *chūnlián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2605

Spring Flowers
chapter topic; Chapter 224, p. 1767
spring outing 春游 (chūnyóu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 3315
square dancing *guǎngchǎngwǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2915
stage (in a theatre) *wǔtái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3859
stairs; staircase *lóutī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 943
stairwell; corridor (in a block of flats) *lóudào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2935
stamina; physical fitness 体力 (tǐlì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3635
standard to measure by *biāozhǔn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2827
star 星星 (xīngxing)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 593
star; celebrity 明星 (míngxīng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 2071
star player; sports star 球星 (qiúxīng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3829
starlight 星光 (xīngguāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3947
Starting Over
chapter topic; Chapter 295, p. 2319
starting point 起点 (qǐdiǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 3149
Starting School
chapter topic; Chapter 304, p. 2387
state of mind; psychology 心理 (xīnlǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2729
station; stop 车站 (chēzhàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 897
station waiting room *hòuchēshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 3111
stationmaster; head of a station 站长 (zhànzhǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 3111
Staying Well
chapter topic; Chapter 484, p. 3707
steady; calm and reliable *wěnzhòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3595
steamed bun *bāozi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 609

Steamed or Fried
chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 1377
stepmother 后妈 (hòumā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3889
still; yet 还 (hái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1261
stingy; mean (with money) 小气 (xiǎoqì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 2057
stomach and gut; digestion *chángwèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3657
stone; rock *shítou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1921
Stops and Stations
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 897
story *gùshi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1953
straight on; all the way *yìzhí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1581
strange; odd *qíguài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1711
stranger 生人 (shēngrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2929
Strength
chapter topic; Chapter 474, p. 3635
strong point; merit *yōudiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2887
strong; tough (in spirit) *jiānqiáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3589
stubborn *gùzhí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3605
student, now read and written 学生 (xuésheng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 121
study; a room for books and work 书房 (shūfáng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1311
study; learn, now read and written 学 (xué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 121
style; design *kuǎnshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1673
subordinate; someone under one at work *xiàshǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3755
suburbs; outskirts *jiāoqū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 3387
Success or Failure
chapter topic; Chapter 394, p. 3047

suddenly; all of a sudden 突然 (tūrán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 2159
sugar; sweets *táng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1377
suì — years of age, and the sentence that says how old you are without a verb in it 岁 (suì)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 27, p. 269
summer *xiàtiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 3931
sun *tàiyang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 593
sun, and also day 日 (rì)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 41
Sunday 星期天 (xīngqītiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 421
sunny day; fine weather *qíngtiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1113
sunrise 日出 (rìchū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 3343
sunscreen *fángshàishuāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 3411
Sunshine
chapter topic; Chapter 518, p. 3955
sunshine 阳光 (yángguāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3955
supermarket *chāoshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 855
supposing that 假如 (jiǎrú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 534, p. 4073
sure enough; as expected 果然 (guǒrán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 2365
Surely Not
chapter topic; Chapter 397, p. 3069
surely not (in a question) 难道 (nándào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 3069
surgical operation *shǒushù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1889
surprised; taken aback *chījīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 2099
Surprises
chapter topic; Chapter 462, p. 3543
surroundings; the area around *zhōuwéi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2921

sweater; jumper *máoyī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1353
sweet *tián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 3449
Sweet and Sour
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 1405
sweet bean paste *dòushā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2659
swindler; con man *piànzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2425
Switching Things On
chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 1399
swollen *zhǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1883
Symptoms
chapter topic; Chapter 480, p. 3679

T

table *zhuōzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 503
table tennis; ping-pong *pīngpāngqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 2037
tablet; pill *yàopiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3695
Take Care
chapter topic; Chapter 245, p. 1915
Take My Advice
chapter topic; Chapter 366, p. 2843
Takeaway
chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 997
takeaway; food delivered *wàimài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 997
Talking It Over
chapter topic; Chapter 348, p. 2709
Tall and Handsome
chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 1023
tall; high *gāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 533
taste; flavour *wèidao*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1405
Tastes
chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 3449; Chapter 449, p. 3449

tasting bad; horrible to eat *nánchī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1439
tasty; good to eat 好吃 (hǎochī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 601
taxi *chūzūchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 405
tea *chá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 367
tea leaves *cháyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1361
Tea Time
chapter topic; Chapter 166, p. 1361
teacher *lǎoshī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 337
Teaching and Practising
chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 1003
teacup 茶杯 (chábēi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1391
team captain; team leader *duìzhǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3815
tears *yǎnlèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3611
teenage boy; teenager 少年 (shàonián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2525
telephone; phone call 电话 (diànhuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 2505
television *diànshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 919
Telling the Time
chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 439
temper; anger 火气 (huǒqì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 3559
temper; temperament *píqi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3581
temperature *wēndù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1903
ten — and the last of the ten words that build every number to ninety-nine 十 (shí)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 20, p. 199
ten thousand *wàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 1083
Ten Words, Ninety-Nine Numbers
chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 213

tennis *wǎngqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 2037
tent *zhàngpeng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 3387
terminus; the end of the line *zhōngdiǎnzhàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 3141
terrain; lie of the land *dìxíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 3351
text message *duǎnxìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 983
than; compared with 比 (bǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1251
thank you — the same character twice, and the second one goes light 谢谢 (xièxie)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 93
Thanks and Replies
chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 663
Thanks, but No
chapter topic; Chapter 355, p. 2761
Thanks for the Help
chapter topic; Chapter 457, p. 3507
that 那 (nà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 351
That Makes Sense
chapter topic; Chapter 351, p. 2729
that one 那个 (nàge)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 351
that same day; on that very day 当天 (dàngtiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 2319
the ancients; people of long ago 古人 (gǔrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2511
the art of dance *wǔdǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3859
the back of the body *hòubèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3643
the beauty of spring; spring sunshine 春光 (chūnguāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3963
The Boss
chapter topic; Chapter 491, p. 3755
the bride and groom 新人 (xīnrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 2401
the built-up part of a city; downtown 市区 (shìqū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 3441

the Chinese language; Mandarin 汉语 (hànyǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 147
The City
chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 691
the countryside; a farming village *nóngcūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1775
the day after tomorrow 后天 (hòutiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1187
The Day Before Yesterday
chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 1369
the day before yesterday 前天 (qiántiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1369
the digit and the character — which one a price, a date and a phone number use *5* **— 五** (wǔ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 213
the earth; our planet *dìqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2943
the east; on the east side *dōngbian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 2207
the effect it has (how well it works) *xiàoguǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 537, p. 4095
The Entrance Exam
chapter topic; Chapter 494, p. 3777
the far bank; the opposite bank *duì'àn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 3395
the floor of a room; floorboards *dìbǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3983
the four seasons 四季 (sìjì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3931
The Grammar That Is Not There
chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 221
the Great Wall 长城 (Chángchéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 3433
the heart as an organ *xīnzàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3657
The Hotel
chapter topic; Chapter 425, p. 3273
the human world 人间 (rénjiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2591
The Information Desk
chapter topic; Chapter 454, p. 3487
The Key Point
chapter topic; Chapter 370, p. 2873

The King's Son
chapter topic; Chapter 330, p. 2577
the Lantern Festival *Yuánxiāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2613
the left; on the left *zuǒbian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 699
the life of a living thing *shēngmìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 2357
the light of the sky; how dark the sky is getting 天色 (tiānsè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 3473
the Mid-Autumn Festival 中秋 (Zhōngqiū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2667
the middle; between *zhōngjiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 699
the middle of the night *bànyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1179
the middle of the term; midterm 期中 (qīzhōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3785
the moon *yuèliang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1871
the news; news on TV and radio *xīnwén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 2285
The Next Day
chapter topic; Chapter 279, p. 2159
the next day; the following day 第二天 (dì'èr tiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 2159
The North
chapter topic; Chapter 438, p. 3365
the north of the country; northern China 北方 (běifāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 3351
the north; on the north side *běibian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 2207
The Old Town
chapter topic; Chapter 446, p. 3425
the open country; the wild *yěwài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 3387
the open sea *dàhǎi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1871
the other side; the other party *duìfāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2709
the outside world 外界 (wàijiè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2547
the owner of a lost item *shīzhǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 3501

the palm of the hand 手心 (shǒuxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3643
the particle between a verb and how well it is done 得 (de)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1241
The Police Car
chapter topic; Chapter 311, p. 2439
the question particle, recovered without pinyin 吗 (ma)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 185
The Rest of the Family
chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 321
the right; on the right *yòubian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 699
The River
chapter topic; Chapter 442, p. 3395
the same; alike *yíyàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 807
the same feeling 同感 (tónggǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2739
the score of a game *bǐfēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3821
the seaside; the seashore *hǎibiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1789
The Security Guard
chapter topic; Chapter 382, p. 2957
the sequence of events; what happened 经过 (jīngguò)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 2401
the sky *tiānkōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1871
the small hours; before dawn *língchén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1445
the south of the country; southern China 南方 (nánfāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 3351
the south; on the south side *nánbian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 2207
the Spring Festival; Chinese New Year 春节 (Chūnjié)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1119
the Spring Festival Gala 春晚 (Chūnwǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2599
The Team
chapter topic; Chapter 499, p. 3815
The Terminal
chapter topic; Chapter 415, p. 3199
the way something is done; method 做法 (zuòfǎ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2715

The Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 577
The Wedding
chapter topic; Chapter 306, p. 2401
The Week
chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 421
the west; on the west side *xībian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 2207
the whole chain of causes and effects 前因后果 (qiányīn hòuguǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 540, p. 4117
the whole country; nationwide 全国 (quánguó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2949
The Whole Family
chapter topic; Chapter 381, p. 2949
the whole family 全家 (quánjiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2949
the words of a song; lyrics *gēcí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3851
the workplace; the world of work 职场 (zhíchǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3755
then; after that *ránhòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1219
then; right away 就 (jiù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 2263
there 那儿 (nàr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 719
these 这些 (zhèxiē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 1043
These and Those
chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 1043
they; them 他们 (tāmen)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 305
thick fog *dàwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3955
thief 小偷 (xiǎotōu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2425
thin (of cloth or paper) *báo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1597
thin; slim *shòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 807
thing; things *dōngxi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 391
Things I Can Do
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 927

Things I Carry
chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 971
Things You Carry
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 511
Thinking It Over
chapter topic; Chapter 346, p. 2695
thirsty *kě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 367
this 这 (zhè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 351
this one 这个 (zhège)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 351
This One and That One
chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 351
This One or That One
chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 1261
this year 今年 (jīnnián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 429
those 那些 (nàxiē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 1043
thousand 千 (qiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 1083
Thousands
chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 1083
three 三 (sān)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 25
thrilled; keyed up *xīngfèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 3515
throat; voice *sǎngzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1755
Through the Gates
chapter topic; Chapter 405, p. 3127
thunderstorm *léiyǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3925
ticket *piào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 3105
ticket office *shòupiàochù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 3119
ticket seller; bus conductor *shòupiàoyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 3157
Tickets and Flights
chapter topic; Chapter 196, p. 1573
Tickets, Please
chapter topic; Chapter 404, p. 3119

tiger *lǎohǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1761
tight *jǐn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1597
time; free time *shíjiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 705
time; moment *shíhou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 421
Time Off Work
chapter topic; Chapter 263, p. 2043
time (one occurrence) *cì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1141
time zone 时区 (shíqū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 3001
timetable *shíkèbiǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 1009
timid; easily scared *dǎnxiǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 3549
tip; a tip for the waiter *xiǎofèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 3473
title; question on a test *tímù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2753
to accept *jiēshòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 2127
to achieve; to obtain (through effort) 取得 (qǔdé)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 3053
to adapt; to adjust to new surroundings *shìyìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2455
to adjust *tiáozhěng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 3091
to admire; to appreciate *xīnshǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 2139
to admit; to own up *chéngrèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2433
to admit you were wrong *rèncuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2775
to affect; influence; to have an effect on *yǐngxiǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 2313
to agree *tóngyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 2093
to agree on a time; to fix (a time or place) together 约定 (yuēdìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 3015
to agree (to a request); to say yes *dāying*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 2127

to allow; to permit *yǔnxǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1667
to alter; to amend 改 (gǎi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 3031
to analyse *fēnxī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2729
to announce officially *xuānbù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 2291
to answer *huídá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 1003
to apologise *dàoqiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 2127
to appear in the papers; to make the papers 见报 (jiànbào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 2305
to appear; to turn up 出现 (chūxiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1857
to apply for *shēnqǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 3495
to apply for a job *yìngpìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3721
to approve of; to be in favour *zànchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 2093
to argue back; to refute *fǎnbó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2745
to argue in favour of; to advocate *zhǔzhāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2715
to argue over a point; to debate *zhēnglùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2709
to arise; to come about *chǎnshēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 538, p. 4103
to arrange *ānpái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1653
to arrange to meet; to make a date with *yuē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1459
to arrive; to reach *dào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 621
to ask *wèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 483
to ask a favour of someone *bàituō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 3507
to ask around; to inquire *dǎting*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1717
to ask for help; to turn to someone for help *qiúzhù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 3501

to ask for time off 请假 (qǐngjià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 2043
to ask the way 问路 (wènlù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1581
to attach importance to *zhòngshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2979
to attain (a goal); to reach a level *dádào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3917
to avoid *bìmiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2843
to bandage; to dress a wound *bāozā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3663
to be afraid of; to fear *pà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 461
to be against; to oppose *fǎnduì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 2093
to be allergic *guòmǐn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3679
to be — and how Mandarin says yes 是 (shì)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 51
to be at; in, at 在 (zài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 719
to be born 出生 (chūshēng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1983
to be bound for a place 开往 (kāiwǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 3287
to be called; to call 叫 (jiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 329
to be careful; to mind (something) 小心 (xiǎoxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 963
to be certain; to settle on *quèdìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 3015
to be delayed; to be held up *yánwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 3205
to be dying to; to be eager for (colloquial) *bābude*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 532, p. 4057
to be frozen stiff *dòngjiāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3925
to be grounded (of planes) 停飞 (tíngfēi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 3219
to be handed down; to spread *liúchuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2561
to be haunted *nàoguǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2591

to be in charge (of) *fùzé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 2043
to be in hospital *zhùyuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1889
to be in luck 走运 (zǒuyùn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 4035
to be infuriating; to make people angry 气人 (qìrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 3559
to be late; to arrive late *chídào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 705
to be left over *shèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 3465
to be obliged to; cannot help but 不得不 (bùdébù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 4029
to be on duty *zhíbān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2957
to be open for business *yíngyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 1009
to be open to the public *kāifàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1545
to be out of date; to have expired 过期 (guòqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 3495
to be out of luck; to have bad luck *dǎoméi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 4035
to be particular about *jiǎngjiu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2651
to be pregnant; to be expecting a baby *huáiyùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 2373
to be reasonable; to listen to reason *jiǎnglǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2729
to be rescued; to be saved from danger 得救 (déjiù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 2351
to be reunited as a family *tuányuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2637
to be scared *hàipà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1857
to be short of; to (before the hour) *chà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1161
to be unable to sleep; to lie awake at night *shīmián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3679
to be used to; a habit *xíguàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1305
to be wasted (of effort) *báifèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 3047

to be willing (to) 愿意 (yuànyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 535, p. 4079
to be willing to; to agree to *kěn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2761
to be windy *guāfēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1113
to be worth it; to be worth doing *zhíde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2843
to become 成为 (chéngwéi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2971
to become famous 成名 (chéngmíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3911
to become infected *gǎnrǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3687
to become inflamed *fāyán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1883
to become reality (of a wish) 成真 (chéngzhēn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 536, p. 4087
to begin; to start *kāishǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 1009
to believe; to trust *xiāngxìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 2093
to bend *wān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3643
to bleed *liúxuè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1831
to blink; to wink *zhǎyǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3611
to bloom; to flower 开花 (kāihuā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1767
to board a plane *dēngjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 3185
to boil; to cook in water *zhǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 951
to boil water *shāoshuǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1377
to book ahead *yùdìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 3281
to borrow; to lend *jiè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 1699
to bow *jūgōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2805
to break a bone *gǔzhé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 2365

to break a rule; to go against the law *wéifǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2791
to break out suddenly; sudden 突发 (tūfā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 2291
to break the law *fànfǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2915
to break the speed limit *chāosù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 3241
to break the traffic rules *wéizhāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 3235
to break; to smash *dǎpò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1505
to break up; to end a relationship *fēnshǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2409
to breathe *hūxī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1877
to bring back to life 救活 (jiùhuó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 2373
to bring in the harvest; to reap *shōuhuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3931
to bring; to take along *dài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 761
to broadcast; a broadcast *guǎngbō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 2299
to broadcast live; a live show *zhíbō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 2299
to brush one's teeth *shuāyá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 847
to bully; to pick on *qīfu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3881
to buy 买 (mǎi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 375
to buy a ticket on board *bǔpiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 3119
to calculate; to work out *suàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1141
to call at a station or port *tíngkào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 3127
to call at the house (to do a job) 上门 (shàngmén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3983
to call back; to return a call 回电 (huídiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2497
to call on; to visit (a person) *kànwàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1459

to call the police *bàojǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1711
to camp out *lùyíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1775
to cancel; to call off *qǔxiāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1843
to care about *guānxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 1017
to care for the sick; to tend 护理 (hùlǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3695
to carry in the hand (by a handle) *līn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 3481
to carry messages between people 传话 (chuánhuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2561
to carry on; to continue *jìxù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1909
to catch a chill *zháoliáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1755
to catch a cold; a cold *gǎnmào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 1883
to catch fire *zháohuǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1433
to catch fish (for a living) *bǔyú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 3403
to catch in time; to make it onto a train *gǎnshàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 3023
to cause damage or trouble *zàochéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 537, p. 4095
to celebrate 庆祝 (qìngzhù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2643
to celebrate a festival 过节 (guòjié)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2637
to celebrate the New Year *guònián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1119
to change a booking; to change a ticket to another train *gǎiqiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 3135
to change careers *gǎiháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 3097
to change one's tune; to take back what one said 改口 (gǎikǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 3031
to change over time; a change *biànhuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1903
to change planes *zhuǎnjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 3205

to change the date (of an event) 改期 (gǎiqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 3031
to change the name (of) 改名 (gǎimíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 3031
to change; to exchange *huàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 911
to change trains or lines *huànchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 3105
to charge a battery *chōngdiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 919
to chase; to run after *zhuī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2439
to chat *liáotiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 711
to cheat in an exam *zuòbì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3785
to cheat; to con *piàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2425
to check in a suitcase; to send luggage in the hold *tuōyùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 3199
to check in (at a hotel) *rùzhù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 3281
to check in for a flight *zhíjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 3219
to check out (of a hotel) *tuìfáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 3281
to check tickets 检票 (jiǎnpiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 3119
to check; to examine *jiǎnchá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1661
to cheer someone on; come on! *jiāyóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 2037
to cherish and protect; to treat with care *àihù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2915
to cherish the memory of; to look back fondly on *huáiniàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2519
to choose *xuǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1673
to claim lost property *rènlǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 3501
to clap; to applaud *gǔzhǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 2003
to clean (a room); to sweep 打扫 (dǎsǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1091

to clear up (of the sky) *fàngqíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1733
to click (on a screen) *diǎnjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1631
to climb a mountain *dēngshān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 3343
to climb; to crawl *pá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 905
to close (for the day); to shut the door *guānmén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1271
to collect things *shōují*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 2121
to comb one's hair *shūtóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 847
to come 来 (lái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 343
to come and go 来往 (láiwǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 3287
to come back 回来 (huílái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1537
to come down a mountain 下山 (xiàshān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 3343
to come from 来自 (láizì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2417
to come in; to enter 进 (jìn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 637
to come in to shore *kào'àn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 3179
to come inside; to come in 进来 (jìnlái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1481
to come of age; fully grown *chéngnián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2687
to come off worse; to lose out *chīkuī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 539, p. 4109
to come over 过来 (guòlai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1459
to come to an end; to finish *jiéshù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 1009
to come true; to make real *shíxiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 3053
to comfort; to console *ānwèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2463
to commemorate; to honour the memory of *jìniàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2533

to commit a crime *fànzuì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2417
to commit to memory; to keep in mind *jìzhù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 2387
to complain; to grumble *bàoyuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2929
to complete; to get (a job) done *wánchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 3053
to congratulate *gōngxǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2629
to cook 做饭 (zuòfàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 601
to cough *késou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1755
to count *shǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 1083
to count on someone *zhǐwàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 532, p. 4057
to crash into; to bump into *zhuàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1831
to create (art or writing) *chuàngzuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3843
to criticize *pīpíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2775
to cry; to weep *kū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 461
to cut; to slice *qiē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 951
to dance *tiàowǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 927
to deal with *chǔlǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 4109
to deal with the paperwork; to go through a procedure *bànlǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 3219
to decide; a decision *juédìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1487
to declare goods at customs *shēnbào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 3213
to decline politely *xièjué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2761
to deep-fry *zhá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1377
to defeat; to beat (an opponent) *dǎbài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 2037

to deliver goods *sònghuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1705
to deny *fǒurèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2761
to depend on (a factor); to hinge on *qǔjuéyú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 3077
to develop; to expand *fāzhǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2901
to dial a number *bōdǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2505
to die 死 (sǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 2357
to digest *xiāohuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 3473
to disappear; to vanish *xiāoshī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2569
to discover; to find out *fāxiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1857
to discuss *tǎolùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2709
to disinfect *xiāodú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3695
to dislike; to hate *tǎoyàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 2139
to disturb *dǎrǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1667
to divorce *líhūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2409
to do a fitness routine; to do physical exercises *zuòcāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1741
to do ahead of time; to bring forward (a date) *tíqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 3001
to do an internship; to work as a trainee *shíxí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3721
to do better to; might as well; to be not as good as 不如 (bùrú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2835
to do the washing-up; to wash the dishes *xǐwǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1319
to do; to make 做 (zuò)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 761
to do training (for a sport); to drill *xùnliàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3815
to do up a home; to renovate *zhuāngxiū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2455

to donate *juān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2907
to dote on 疼爱 (téng'ài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3897
to download *xiàzài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 919
to drag someone into trouble *liánlei*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 540, p. 4117
to draw for prizes; to hold a prize draw *chōujiǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 4043
to draw lots *chōuqiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 4029
to dream of; to see in a dream *mèngjiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 536, p. 4087
to dream; to have a dream *zuòmèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1305
to dress up; to get dressed up *dǎban*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1347
to drink 喝 (hē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 367
to drink alcohol *hējiǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1877
to drive 开车 (kāichē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 621
to drop coins in the box *tóubì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 3149
to dry-clean *gānxǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1705
to dry in the sun *shài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1155
to earn money; to make a profit *zhuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3735
to eat 吃 (chī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 359
to eat no meat; to be vegetarian *chīsù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 3465
to ebb (of the tide) *tuìcháo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 3419
to economise; to use sparingly 节约 (jiéyuē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 3009
to educate; to bring up (the young); education *jiàoyù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3769
to emigrate; to settle abroad *yímín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 3359

to encourage *gǔlì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2857
to enjoy *xiǎngshòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 2139
to enjoy the moon *shǎngyuè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2667
to enter a country *rùjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 3213
to enter for an exam; to apply to a school by exam 报考 (bàokǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3777
to envy *xiànmù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 3529
to escape the summer heat *bìshǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3931
to escort 护送 (hùsòng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 3403
to exchange money *duìhuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 3227
to exercise; to work out *duànliàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1107
to exhort; to tell (someone) to be sure to do something *zhǔfu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 3039
to expect much of someone; expectations 期望 (qīwàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 532, p. 4057
to experience for yourself *tǐyàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 2031
to explain *jiěshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 2079
to explode; to blow up *bàozhà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 2357
to extend (in time) *yáncháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 3091
to fail *shībài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 3047
to fail an entrance exam *luòbǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3777
to faint; to pass out *yūndǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 2351
to fall asleep *shuìzháo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1305
to fall due; to run out 到期 (dàoqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 3009
to fall ill; illness *bìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 455

to fall out of love; to stop being faithful 变心 (biànxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 3543
to farm; to work the land *zhòngdì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1775
to feel *gǎndào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1969
to feel deeply grateful *gǎnjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 3507
to feel for someone; to love dearly 心疼 (xīnténg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 3515
to feel (how something seems); a feeling 感觉 (gǎnjué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 2243
to fight a fire; to put out a fire 救火 (jiùhuǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 2343
to fight a war; to go into battle *dǎzhàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2555
to fight; to get into a fistfight *dǎjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2447
to fight to save a patient; to give emergency treatment *qiǎngjiù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 2351
to fill in (a form) *tiánxiě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1521
to find 找到 (zhǎodào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1581
to find employment; to get a job 就业 (jiùyè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3727
to find (that); to feel; to think (that) *juéde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1167
to find time (for something) *chōukòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 3001
to finish class 下课 (xiàkè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 677
to finish (doing) *zuòwán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1229
to finish school for the day; (of a school) to let out *fàngxué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1945
to finish work; to come off a shift *xiàbān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1481
to fire; to dismiss (from a job or school) *kāichú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3749
to fly 飞 (fēi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 3185
to fold *dié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1091

to follow a story closely; to keep an eye on *guānzhù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 2305
to forbid; no (on signs) *jìnzhǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 963
to forget *wàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 817
to forgive *yuánliàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 2127
to form (a habit); to get into a habit *yǎngchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3707
to found; to set up *jiànlì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2547
to freeze over *jiébīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1903
to fry (in a little oil) *jiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 951
to fulfil a dream *yuánmèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 536, p. 4087
to gather; to assemble; to meet up as a group *jíhé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 3337
to get a haircut *lǐfà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1687
to get a lift *dāchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 3301
to get a pay rise; to raise someone's pay *jiāxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3755
to get about; to go out on a journey *chūxíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 3301
to get airsick *yùnjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 3193
to get angry 生气 (shēngqì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 1029
to get back (something lost) 找回 (zhǎohuí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 2231
to get caught in the rain *línyǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3925
to get cheaper; to come down in price *jiàngjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1551
to get dearer; to go up in price *zhǎngjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1551
to get engaged *dìnghūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2395
to get hurt; to be injured *shòushāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1831

to get in touch with; to contact *liánxì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 2231
to get into (a school) by exam; to pass the entrance exam for 考上 (kǎoshàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3777
to get into trouble; to cause a mess *chuǎnghuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 539, p. 4109
to get light at dawn *tiānliàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3947
to get married *jiéhūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1983
to get off (a bus or train) 下车 (xiàchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 3105
to get old 变老 (biànlǎo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 3097
to get on (a bus or train) 上车 (shàngchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 3105
to get out of danger *tuōxiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 4049
to get promoted *shēngzhí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3741
to get ready; to prepare *zhǔnbèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 711
to get seasick *yùnchuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1789
to get separated (in a crowd) *zǒusàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 3501
to get sick; to fall ill 生病 (shēngbìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1883
to get something sent; to receive *shōudào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1611
to get the jobs done; to work *gànhuó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1319
to get the wrong idea; to misunderstand *wùhuì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2849
to get there on foot *bùxíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 3433
to get through on the phone *dǎtōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2505
to get up *qǐchuáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 455
to get up; to stand up 起来 (qǐlai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1305

to get well again; to convalesce *kāngfù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3701
to get what one wished for 如愿 (rúyuàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 535, p. 4079
to give a discount; to be on sale *dǎzhé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 1009
to give a gentle smile *wēixiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3573
to give a present *sònglǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2621
to give a running commentary 解说 (jiěshuō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 3315
to give a send-off 欢送 (huānsòng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2621
to give an example *jǔlì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2865
to give as a present; to see off *sòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 647
to give back *huán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 1699
to give blood *xiànxuè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3671
to give change *zhǎoqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 957
to give directions; to show someone the way *zhǐlù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 3487
to give medical treatment; to cure *zhìliáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3695
to give off light; to shine 发光 (fāguāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3947
to give official approval; to approve a plan *pīzhǔn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2827
to give one's word; to pledge *xǔnuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 534, p. 4073
to give rise to; to bring about *yǐnqǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 2313
to give the money back; to refund *tuìkuǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 4005
to give; to, for 给 (gěi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 761
to give up *fàngqì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2843
to give up all hope; to despair *juéwàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 533, p. 4065

to give up drinking *jièjiǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3707
to give up hope 死心 (sǐxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 3543
to give up one's seat (to someone) *ràngzuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2915
to give up smoking *jièyān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1877
to give your approval; to accept as good *rènkě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2739
to go 去 (qù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 397
to go abroad 出国 (chūguó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1537
to go ashore *shàng'àn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 3419
to go back there 回去 (huíqù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1537
to go back; to return *huí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 397
to go direct; to go without changing *zhídá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 3127
to go diving; to dive under water *qiánshuǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 3411
to go fishing *diàoyú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1149
to go home from abroad; to return to one's own country 回国 (huíguó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1537
to go in and out 出入 (chūrù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 3127
to go into 进入 (jìnrù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 3127
to go missing *shīzōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2417
to go north; to head up north 北上 (běishàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 3249
to go on holiday; to spend a holiday *dùjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1487
to go on to a higher school; to go on to further study *shēngxué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3799
to go online 上网 (shàngwǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 919

to go out *chūmén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 397
to go out to sea 出海 (chūhǎi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 3329
to go out with someone; to be in a relationship *tán liàn'ài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2395
to go outside; to go out of here 出去 (chūqù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1481
to go shopping; to do some shopping *gòuwù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 3337
to go sightseeing *guānguāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 3309
to go south; to head down south 南下 (nánxià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 3257
to go to market day; to go to a country market *gǎnjí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 3379
to go to town; to move to the city 进城 (jìnchéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 3425
to go to work *shàngbān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 685
to go upstairs *shànglóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1647
to graduate; to finish school *bìyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1983
to grasp a meaning; to understand; clear 明白 (míngbai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1699
to grow up 长大 (zhǎngdà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 669
to guess *cāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2613
to haggle *jiǎngjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1551
to hang out to dry *liàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1453
to hang; to hang up *guà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1419
to hang up the phone; to end a call *guàduàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2505
to happen; to take place *fāshēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1369
to hate deeply; to resent *hèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 3543
to hate to part with; to hate to leave *shěbude*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2455

to have a fall; to drop (and break) *shuāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1505
to have a fever *fāshāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 1883
to have a group photo taken; to pose for a group photo *héyǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 3315
to have a meeting 开会 (kāihuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1293
to have a picnic; a picnic *yěcān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1339
to have a power cut *tíngdiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1369
to have a runny nose *liú bítì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3679
to have a serious talk *tánhuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2753
to have a shave; to shave one's face *guāliǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1347
to have a shower; to have a bath *xǐzǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 847
to have a tooth filled *bǔyá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3627
to have a tooth pulled *báyá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3627
to have an accident; for something to go wrong 出事 (chūshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1831
to have an injection; to give one *dǎzhēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1795
to have an interview (for a job); interview 面试 (miànshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 2133
to have class; to start class 上课 (shàngkè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 677
to have diarrhoea; to have an upset stomach *lā dùzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1883
to have free time; to be free *yǒukòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1339
to have no choice but to *zhǐhǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1849
to have something on; to be busy *yǒushì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 817
to have the family name; family name *xìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 329
to have time off; to go on holiday *fàngjià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 1119

to have to; must *děi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 2195
to help *bāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 1699
to help out; to do a favour *bāngmáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 1699
to help up; to hold up with a hand *fú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 2365
to hide *cáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2585
to hold a ceremony; to hold an event *jǔxíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 2401
to hope 希望 (xīwàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 533, p. 4065
to ice-skate *huábīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 2121
to impose a fine; a penalty fine *fákuǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2447
to improve; to make progress *jìnbù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 2025
to increase *zēngjiā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2971
to inherit; to take over (from a parent) *jìchéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2577
to install; to put in *ānzhuāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1661
to interview someone for the news *cǎifǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 2291
to introduce *jièshào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 637
to invent; an invention 发明 (fāmíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 2291
to investigate *diàochá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2439
to invite; an invitation *yāoqǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1411
to iron *yùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1453
to itch *fāyǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3679
to jump *tiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 905
to jump the queue *chāduì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2797

to keep an animal; to raise *yǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1803
to keep as a souvenir *liúniàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 3337
to keep at it; to persist *jiānchí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2843
to keep someone company; to go along with *péi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1339
to keep the New Year vigil *shǒusuì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2599
to keep; to save *bǎocún*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2681
to keep to; to abide by *zūnshǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2791
to keep up; to keep as it is *bǎochí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1667
to kick *tī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 1107
to knock at the door *qiāomén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1433
to know a fact; to be aware *zhīdào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 541
to know from experience; to come to understand 体会 (tǐhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2701
to know in depth; to find out about 了解 (liǎojiě)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2849
to know someone; to recognise *rènshi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 329
to know well; to be familiar with *shúxī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2477
to land; to come down onto the runway *jiàngluò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 3185
to laugh; to smile *xiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 2121
to launch a new transport line 开通 (kāitōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 3165
to lay out a room; to decorate a room *bùzhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3977
to lead to 通往 (tōngwǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 3295
to leak water *lòushuǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3983
to learn a text by heart; to recite from memory *bèishū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3791

to learn (and now be able to) 学会 (xuéhuì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1229
to leave a country *chūjìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 3213
to leave a message *liúyán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1589
to leave a place *líkāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 905
to leave behind *liúxià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2533
to leave hospital *chūyuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1889
to leave in safekeeping *jìcún*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1705
to leave it till later 再说 (zàishuō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 655
to lie down *tǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1481
to lie; to tell a lie *shuōhuǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2433
to lift; to carry (between two people) *tái*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1419
to light a fire 生火 (shēnghuǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 3387
to listen; to hear *tīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 475
to live; alive 活 (huó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 2373
to live somewhere; to stay *zhù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 337
to lock the door; to lock up *suǒmén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1481
to lodge with a local family; to stay the night at someone's home *jièsù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 3379
to log in *dēnglù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1631
to look after; to take care of *zhàogù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1319
to look after your guests; to entertain *zhāodài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2805
to look after yourself; to take care of oneself *bǎozhòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1915

to look at or watch, recovered without pinyin 看 (kàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 171
to look down on 看不起 (kànbuqǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2805
to look for *zhǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 2505
to look forward to; to long for *pànwàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 3535
to look round a place; to visit (a sight) *cānguān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1487
to lose (a thing) *diū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 971
to lose one's grip; to do by a slip of the hand *shīshǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 4049
to lose one's job; to be out of work *shīyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3727
to lose one's temper 发火 (fāhuǒ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 3559
to lose weight; to diet *jiǎnféi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1741
to lose your way; to get lost *mílù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1581
to love *ài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 489
to love deeply *rè'ài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 2139
to make a bet *dǎdǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 4029
to make a booking; to order *dìng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 997
to make a choice *xuǎnzé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2857
to make a formal complaint *tóusù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 4005
to make a judgement; to judge *pànduàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2723
to make a wish *xǔyuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2629
to make an appointment; to book *yùyuē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1687
to make an inquiry; to ask for advice *zīxún*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 3487
to make conditions better *gǎishàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 541, p. 4123

to make different (a plan or a habit) 改变 (gǎibiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 3031
to make something clear; to explain clearly 说明 (shuōmíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2865
to make something of oneself 成才 (chéngcái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3911
to make tea (to steep the leaves) *pàochá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1361
to make the bed *pūchuáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1319
to make your view known; to express *biǎoshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2739
to manage; to be in charge of *guǎnlǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3749
to marry and settle down 成家 (chéngjiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 3083
to mature (as a person) 成长 (chéngzhǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 3097
to meet (a requirement); to satisfy *mǎnzú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 3083
to meet someone off a plane *jiējī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 3227
to meet up; to see each other *jiànmiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 711
to melt; to thaw *rónghuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3925
to mention; to bring up a subject 说起 (shuōqǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2505
to miss a chance; to miss a train 错过 (cuòguò)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2767
to miss a flight *wùjī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 3205
to miss an appointment *shīyuē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 3001
to miss someone *xiǎngniàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2539
to mop the floor *tuōdì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1155
to move house; to move (something heavy) *bān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 905
to move to another employer; to change jobs *tiàocáo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3741
to move; to touch someone's heart *gǎndòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 2099

to my surprise; unexpectedly *jìngrán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2469
to name a baby; to give a name 起名 (qǐmíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 2381
to name one's price; to ask a price 要价 (yàojià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3997
to navigate by satnav *dǎoháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 3249
to need *xūyào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 779
to nod 点头 (diǎntóu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1795
to not allow 不准 (bùzhǔn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2827
to notify; a notice *tōngzhī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1293
to offer a lower price back; to make a counter-offer 还价 (huánjià)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3997
to open (for business); to open the door 开门 (kāimén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1271
to open; to switch on *kāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 567
to open; to switch on 打开 (dǎkāi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1399
to open to traffic 通车 (tōngchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 3157
to open up land for use 开发 (kāifā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 3365
to order food *diǎncài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 3449
to pack food to take away 打包 (dǎbāo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 997
to paint pictures; to draw *huàhuà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 927
to pass an exam *jígé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 2079
to pass away 去世 (qùshì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2539
to pass by (on the way somewhere) 路过 (lùguò)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 2207
to pass on a message *zhuǎngào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2491

to pass on (an illness); to be catching *chuánrǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1915
to pass the ball 传球 (chuánqiú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3815
to pass through 通过 (tōngguò)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 3165
to patrol *xúnluó*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2957
to pay *fù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 957
to pay a New Year call *bàinián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2599
to pay a visit to *bàifǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2637
to pay attention; to take care *zhùyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 963
to pay by card *shuākǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 957
to pay for damage *péiqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 2329
to pay for everyone; to treat (the others) 请客 (qǐngkè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1411
to pay the bill *mǎidān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 957
to perform a song (on stage) *yǎnchàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3851
to perform on an instrument *yǎnzòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3867
to perform on stage *yǎnchū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 2003
to phone; to make a phone call 打电话 (dǎ diànhuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 2505
to photocopy *fùyìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1687
to pick fruit; to pick flowers *zhāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1775
to pick out; to choose *tiāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1597
to place an order *xiàdān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 4023
to plan to; to intend *dǎsuàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1197
to plant trees *zhòngshù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2971

to play an instrument; to pluck *tán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 927
to play ball *dǎqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 2121
to play chess *xiàqí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1953
to play the drums *dǎgǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 2003
to play; to have fun *wán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 2121
to pollute *wūrǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2943
to post; to send by post *jì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 983
to practise *liànxí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 1003
to praise (in front of others) *biǎoyáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2775
to prepare a lesson (before class) *yùxí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1945
to prescribe medicine *kāiyào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1821
to press; to push down *àn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1399
to prevent; to guard against *yùfáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3707
to print out *dǎyìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1687
to promise; to guarantee *bǎozhèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2957
to propose a toast *jìngjiǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2805
to propose marriage *qiúhūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2395
to protect; to keep from harm 保护 (bǎohù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 3403
to prove *zhèngmíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2723
to publish an article; to make public *fābiǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 2299
to pull *lā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 943
to pull into the station (of a train or bus) 进站 (jìnzhàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 3141

to pursue (a goal); to chase a dream *zhuīqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3911
to push *tuī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 943
to push hard; to put one's strength into it 用力 (yònglì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3635
to push up (a level) *tígāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2979
to put a limit on; to restrict *xiànzhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2791
to put a mistake right *gǎizhèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2767
to put a question (in class or a meeting) *tíwèn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2753
to put money by; to put money in the bank *cúnqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1567
to put off; to postpone *tuīchí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1843
to put on make-up *huàzhuāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1347
to put on the brakes; a brake *shāchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 2329
to put the blame on someone 怪 (guài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 539, p. 4109
to put; to place *fàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 761
to put up an umbrella *dǎsǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3955
to quarrel; to have a row *chǎojià*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1433
to queue; to line up *páiduì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1545
to rain *xiàyǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 577
to reach a destination; to arrive *dàodá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1573
to read a book or read books 看书 (kànshū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 171
to read aloud; to study *dú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 483
to recall; to think back on *huíyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1927
to receive; to accept *shōu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 983

to receive visitors; to take care of guests *jiēdài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 3329
to reckon; to make a rough guess *gūjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2695
to recommend *tuījiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1439
to recover; to get back to normal *huīfù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1889
to recruit; to advertise a job *zhāopìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3721
to recycle *huíshōu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2949
to reduce; to cut down *jiǎnshǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2965
to refuse; to turn down *jùjué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 2051
to regard (in a certain way) *kàndài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2715
to register at a clinic; to register at a hospital *guàhào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1821
to register officially *dēngjì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2477
to regret *hòuhuǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1505
to rehearse *páiliàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3859
to relax; to loosen *fàngsōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1487
to relieve stress *jiǎnyā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3713
to remarry *zàihūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2409
to remember *jìde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1717
to remind *tíxǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2827
to rent *zū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1623
to repair; to fix *xiū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 875
to repeat a school year *liújí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3791
to reply (to a message) *huífù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1293

to report in on arrival; to sign in 报到 (bàodào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 2387
to report on; a news report *bàodào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 2285
to report the loss of (a card or document) *guàshī*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 2231
to require; to demand (of someone) *yāoqiú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 3083
to resemble; to take after *xiàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 1023
to resign; to quit a job *cízhí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 2133
to rest *xiūxi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 455
to result in something bad *dǎozhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 537, p. 4095
to retire *tuìxiū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 2133
to return a ticket (for a refund) *tuìpiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 2219
to reverse the car; to back up *dàochē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 3235
to revise; to correct (a piece of work) *xiūgǎi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1959
to revise; to go over again *fùxí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 1003
to ride (a bike or a horse) *qí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 897
to ripen; to be ripe *chéngshú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3939
to rise after rain (of a river) *zhǎngshuǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 3395
to roast; to bake *kǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 951
to rob by force *qiǎngjié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2425
to row a boat *huáchuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1921
to run away; to flee *táo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 2365
to run behind schedule; to be late (of a train or plane) 晚点 (wǎndiǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1173

to run into; to come across *yùdào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1789
to run out of time *láibují*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 705
to run the household 当家 (dāngjiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3889
to run; to jog *pǎobù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 2121
to save energy; energy-saving 节能 (jiénéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2979
to say goodbye; to take leave *gàobié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2621
to say hello to someone *dǎ zhāohu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2805
to say; to speak 说 (shuō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 475
to scald; to burn (with heat) *tàngshāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3663
to scan a code (to pay) *sǎomǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1617
to score a goal 进球 (jìnqiú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3807
to scratch; to grab *zhuā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1803
to scrub; to brush clean *shuā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3977
to see a doctor 看病 (kànbìng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 1883
to see a guest out 送客 (sòngkè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2621
to see or catch sight of 看见 (kànjiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 171
to see; to catch sight of 看到 (kàndào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1229
to seek advice (from someone who knows more) 请教 (qǐngjiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3769
to sell *mài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 391
to sell retail *língshòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3989
to sell wholesale *pīfā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3989
to send electronically; to send a message or an email *fāsòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1611

to send regards to; to greet 问候 (wènhòu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1411
to set off; to depart *chūfā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1271
to set out for a place 前往 (qiánwǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 3295
to set out on a journey; to hit the road 上路 (shànglù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 3165
to set sail 开船 (kāichuán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 3171
to set up a street stall *bǎitān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 3441
to settle down; to make a place your home *dìngjū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2455
to settle the bill *jiézhàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3997
to sew; to stitch *féng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3977
to shake hands *wòshǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2621
to shake one's head *yáotóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3651
to share *fēnxiǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2675
to share someone's view; to identify with *rèntóng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2745
to shed tears *liúlèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2463
to shelter from the rain *duǒyǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1843
to shoot at goal *shèmén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3807
to shop online *wǎnggòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2995
to shorten *suōduǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 3091
to shout; to call out *hǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 2343
to show respect for; to respect *zūnzhòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2915
to shut down; to be shut to the public *guānbì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 3323
to shut; to close; to switch off *guān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 567

to sigh *tànqì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 3529
to sign for (a delivery) *qiānshōu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1705
to sign up; to enter (one's name) *bàomíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 2079
to sign your name *qiānmíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1521
to sing *chànggē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 489
to sit in the cool (out of the sun) *chéngliáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3963
to sit; to travel by *zuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 405
to ski *huáxuě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1747
to skip with a rope *tiàoshéng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1741
to sleep in; to lie in *shuì lǎnjiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1173
to sleep; to go to bed *shuìjiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 455
to slip up; to go wrong 出错 (chūcuò)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2767
to smoke *xīyān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 963
to sneeze *dǎ pēntì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1755
to solve; to settle *jiějué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1717
to someone's face; in person 当面 (dāngmiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2761
to soothe a child; to coax *hǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3897
to sort into kinds *fēnlèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2949
to sort out; to put in order *zhěnglǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1155
to sort something out; to do; to handle *nòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1419
to spend less; to save money *shěngqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1513
to spend money *huāqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1513

to sprain *niǔshāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3663
to sprout; to bud *fāyá*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1865
to stand *zhàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 761
to stand someone up *fàng gēzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 3069
to stare blankly; to be lost in a daze *fādāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3573
to start a business; to found an enterprise *chuàngyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3917
to start school *rùxué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 2387
to start the school term 开学 (kāixué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 2381
to stay up late; to stay up all night *áoyè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1383
to steal *tōu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1711
to steam (food) *zhēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1377
to stew *dùn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1377
to stick; to paste up *tiē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2605
to still have time (to do something) *láidejí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 3023
to stir-fry *chǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 951
to stir up trouble; to provoke *rě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 539, p. 4109
to stop the bleeding *zhǐxuè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3671
to stop; to park *tíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 905
to stop worrying; to be at ease *fàngxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 1029
to strive for; to fight for *zhēngqǔ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3917
to stroke; to touch *mō*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1803
to stroll the shops; to go window-shopping *guàngjiē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1149

to struggle (towards a goal) *fèndòu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3917
to study abroad *liúxué*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 2031
to study; to learn *xuéxí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 483
to stuff in; to squeeze in *sāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 3481
to succeed *chénggōng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 3047
to suggest *jiànyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2835
to sum up *zǒngjié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2879
to support; to back *zhīchí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 2093
to suspect; to doubt *huáiyí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2433
to sweat *chūhàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1741
to sweep the floor *sǎodì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1319
to swim *yóuyǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 2025
to switch off (a phone or a computer) 关机 (guānjī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1589
to sympathize with 同情 (tóngqíng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 3529
to take a detour; to take the long way round *ràolù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 3433
to take a photo *zhàoxiàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1653
to take a risk *màoxiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 3047
to take a selfie *zìpāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 3309
to take a taxi 打车 (dǎchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 3157
to take a turn for the better; to start to improve *hǎozhuǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3701
to take a walk *sànbù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1149
to take an exam *kǎoshì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 677

to take extra lessons *bǔxí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3769
to take goods back; to return goods to a shop *tuìhuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1617
to take it seriously; to take at face value 当真 (dàngzhēn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2893
to take medicine *chīyào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1795
to take off (of a plane) *qǐfēi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1573
to take one's mind off things; to unwind *sànxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 3373
to take out money *qǔqián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1567
to take part in; to join *cānjiā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 711
to take the field; to come on (to play) 上场 (shàngchǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3821
to take; to hold *ná*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 875
to talk it over together; to consult *shāngliang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2709
to talk someone round; to persuade *shuōfú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2745
to taste; to sample *pǐncháng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2659
to teach *jiāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 1003
to teach oneself 自学 (zìxué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3799
to tell *gàosu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1699
to tell about; to give an account of *jiǎngshù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2539
to tend the family graves *sǎomù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2651
to thank (warmly) *gǎnxiè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 663
to think hard; to reflect *sīkǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2701
to think highly of; to hold in high regard *pèifú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 3535
to think of; to call to mind 想起 (xiǎngqǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2533

to think something over; to consider *kǎolǜ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2695
to think; to hold a view *rènwéi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1997
to thirst for; to crave *kěwàng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 533, p. 4065
to throw; to throw away *rēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 875
to throw up; to vomit *tù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1883
to thunder *dǎléi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 1113
to tidy up *shōushi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1091
to top up (a card or a phone) *chōngzhí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1687
to topple over; to fall down (of a thing) *dǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1433
to touch; to bump into *pèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1399
to translate; to interpret *fānyì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3735
to travel for work; to go on a business trip *chūchāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1537
to travel; to tour *lǚyóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1149
to tremble; to shiver *fādǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 3549
to trouble; to bother *máfan*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 663
to try; to try on 试 (shì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 911
to turn a corner *guǎi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 935
to turn a phone on; to switch on a phone or a computer 开机 (kāijī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1589
to turn bad (of the weather) 变天 (biàntiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2987
to turn colder; to cool down *jiàngwēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1733
to turn hostile suddenly; to change one's attitude abruptly 变脸 (biànliǎn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3619

to turn into 变成 (biànchéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2987
to turn round (in a car); to make a U-turn *diàotóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 3265
to tutor; to give guidance *fǔdǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3769
to type 打字 (dǎzì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1631
to understand *dǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 475
to understand (on hearing) *tīngdǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1229
to understand (on reading or watching) *kàndǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1229
to understand someone's reasons; to sympathize 理解 (lǐjiě)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2849
to urge; to try to persuade *quàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2827
to use 用 (yòng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 875
to use little electricity; to save electricity *shěngdiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3971
to vent one's anger; to take it out on someone 出气 (chūqì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 3559
to visit as a guest; to be a guest 做客 (zuòkè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1459
to wait for a train or bus 候车 (hòuchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 3105
to wait; to wait for *děng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 439
to wake someone up *jiàoxǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1305
to wake up *xǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1179
to walk the dog *liùgǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1803
to walk; to go on foot *zǒulù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1559
to walk; to leave *zǒu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 397
to want; to ask for *yào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 957
to want to; to think; to miss 想 (xiǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 489

to want; would like 想要 (xiǎngyào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 779
to wash 洗 (xǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 847
to wash one's face *xǐliǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 847
to wash one's hair *xǐtóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1347
to waste *làngfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2965
to watch out; to look out 当心 (dāngxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2843
to water the plants *jiāohuā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1155
to wear; to put on *chuān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 519
to weigh on a scale *chēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 4015
to win a contest; to be victorious *huòshèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3821
to win (a prize); to be awarded *huòdé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3829
to win in a draw; to win a prize *zhòngjiǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 4043
to wipe *cā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 1091
to wish someone well 祝 (zhù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2629
to work as; to be (a job or a role) 当 (dāng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 2253
to work; job *gōngzuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 337
to work out; to keep fit *jiànshēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1741
to work overtime *jiābān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1989
to work part-time; to have a part-time job 打工 (dǎgōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1989
to work together; to cooperate *hézuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3749
to worry *dānxīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 1029
to wrap goods for sale *bāozhuāng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 4023

to write *xiě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 483
to write essays and stories; writing 写作 (xiězuò)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1959
to write to each other; to correspond *tōngxìn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2497
to wrongly assume; to take it that (often wrongly) 以为 (yǐwéi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2695
to yearn for *xiàngwǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 533, p. 4065
today 今天 (jīntiān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 413
Today and Tomorrow
chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 413
tofu; bean curd *dòufu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1439
together 一起 (yìqǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 711
toilet; lavatory *cèsuǒ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1545
toilet; washroom *xǐshǒujiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 727
toll gate *shōufèizhàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 3241
tomorrow *míngtiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 413
tone of voice; way of saying something 口气 (kǒuqì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2775
tongue *shétou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3651
Too Much
chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 797
too; too much *tài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 957
tool *gōngjù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1661
tooth; teeth *yáchǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3627
toothbrush *yáshuā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 891
toothpaste *yágāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 891
top of a mountain; summit *shāndǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 3343

top school; famous university 名校 (míngxiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3911
topic of conversation 话题 (huàtí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2753
tour group *lǚyóutuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 3337
tour guide *dǎoyóu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1693
tourist *yóukè*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1693
towards; in the direction of *wǎng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 2207
towel *máojīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 891
town; walled city 城 (chéng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 3425
toy *wánjù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 2085
tradition *chuántǒng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2651
traditional Chinese medicine; a doctor of it 中医 (zhōngyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1821
traditional Chinese painting 国画 (guóhuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3835
traffic accident; car crash *chēhuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 2329
traffic jam; to be stuck in traffic *dǔchē*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 817
traffic lane 车道 (chēdào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 3235
traffic lights *hónglǜdēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1559
traffic police officer *jiāojǐng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2439
traffic; transport 交通 (jiāotōng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 3157
train 火车 (huǒchē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 621
train attendant *lièchēyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 3111
train or bus ticket 车票 (chēpiào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1573
Trains and Opening Hours
chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 1271

Travel and Fun
chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 1149
travel costs; the cost of getting there *lǜfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 3301
travel notes; account of a journey 游记 (yóujì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 3337
traveller; passenger on a long journey 旅客 (lǚkè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 3111
Travellers
chapter topic; Chapter 403, p. 3111
treasure *bǎowù*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2585
Treatment
chapter topic; Chapter 482, p. 3695
tree 树 (shù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3939
Trees and Leaves
chapter topic; Chapter 516, p. 3939
trousers *kùzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 519
Trying It On
chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 911
tuition fees *xuéfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 2387
tunnel *suìdào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 3265
twenty — two ten, and the same ten words now reach ninety-nine 二十 (èrshí)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 21, p. 213
twilight; the fading light of evening *huánghūn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3947
twins *shuāngbāotāi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 2373
two 二 (èr)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 25
Two Cups of Tea
chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 749
two (of something) 两 (liǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 749
Two pieces again — and a warning about the story
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 11
Two Tickets
chapter topic; Chapter 284, p. 2219
typhoon *táifēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1909

U

ugly *nánkàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 1023
umbrella *yǔsǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 971
unchanged; staying the same 不变 (búbiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 3047
uncle; father's younger brother *shūshu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 2107
uncooked rice; rice grain 大米 (dàmǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1325
under; below *xiàbian*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 727
Under the Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 222, p. 1755
underground; metro *dìtiě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 897
uneasy; worried 不安 (bù'ān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2935
unexpected; beyond what anyone imagined 意想不到 (yìxiǎngbúdào)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 3543
university; college, built from known characters 大学 (dàxué)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 121
university student, built from known characters 大学生 (dàxuésheng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 121
unless *chúfēi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 3061
unused; lying idle *xiánzhì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2987
unwanted noise; din *zàoyīn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2929
Up in the Air
chapter topic; Chapter 413, p. 3185
upper reaches (of a river); upstream 上游 (shàngyóu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 3395
Upstairs
chapter topic; Chapter 206, p. 1647
urgent; a cause for concern 要紧 (yàojǐn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3687
Using Things
chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 875

usually; ordinarily *píngshí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1179

V

valid; effective *yǒuxiào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 3495
version of events; way of putting it 说法 (shuōfa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2715
very fast; as fast as flying 飞快 (fēikuài)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 3185
very nearly; all but *jīhū*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 4049
video *shìpín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1631
view; opinion *kànfǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1997
viewers; spectators; the people watching a show *guānzhòng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 2299
vigour; get-up-and-go *jīngshen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3713
village *cūnzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1921
village head 村长 (cūnzhǎng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 3379
villager *cūnmín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 3379
violin *xiǎotíqín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3867
virus *bìngdú*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3687
visa *qiānzhèng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1693
Visiting
chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 637
voice message; speech sounds 语音 (yǔyīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2505
volunteer *zhìyuànzhě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2907

W

waiter; attendant *fúwùyuán*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 787
Waking Up
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 1305
wallet; purse *qiánbāo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 971
war *zhànzhēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2555
wardrobe *yīguì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1453
Warm-Hearted
chapter topic; Chapter 258, p. 2009
warm-hearted; eager to help 热心 (rèxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 2009
warm; welcoming *rèqíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 1017
washing machine 洗衣机 (xǐyījī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1453
washing powder *xǐyīfěn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1453
water 水 (shuǐ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 367
water bill *shuǐfèi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3983
water heater *rèshuǐqì*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3971
watermelon *xīguā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1865
Way In, Way Out
chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 943
Ways of Seeing
chapter topic; Chapter 349, p. 2715
we; us 我们 (wǒmen)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 305
weak point; shortcoming *quēdiǎn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2893
weather 天气 (tiānqì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 577
weather forecast *tiānqì yùbào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1187
website 网站 (wǎngzhàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1631

wedding *hūnlǐ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1983
wedding dress *hūnshā*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2409
wedding sweets *xǐtáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 2401
week 星期 (xīngqī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 421
weekend *zhōumò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 421
weight; how heavy something is 重量 (zhòngliàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 4015
welcome *huānyíng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 637
Well Said
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 1241
western medicine; a doctor of it 西医 (xīyī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1821
western part; the western regions 西部 (xībù)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 3365
What?
chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 85
What a Day
chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1505
What Do You Do?
chapter topic; Chapter 259, p. 2017
What Do You Mean?
chapter topic; Chapter 347, p. 2701
What Do You Think?
chapter topic; Chapter 256, p. 1997
What Do You Want to Be
chapter topic; Chapter 488, p. 3735
What I Can Do
chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 2025; Chapter 260, p. 2025
What I'd Like
chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 779
What I Think
chapter topic; Chapter 280, p. 2173
What I Want to Be
chapter topic; Chapter 287, p. 2253
what is going on here; what's the matter 怎么回事 (zěnme huí shì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 540, p. 4117
what is really on one's mind; words from the heart 心里话 (xīnlihuà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 3521

What Kind of Person
chapter topic; Chapter 467, p. 3581
what one really meant; original intention 本意 (běnyì)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2739
What People Are Like
chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 1017
what set it off; the starting cause 起因 (qǐyīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 537, p. 4095
what should I do? *zěnme bàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1699
what — the first question word in this book 什么 (shénme)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 85
What You Are Called
chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 329
What You Have to Do
chapter topic; Chapter 362, p. 2811
What You Love
chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 489
Whatever Happens
chapter topic; Chapter 396, p. 3061
When I Was Little
chapter topic; Chapter 269, p. 2085
When Plans Change
chapter topic; Chapter 391, p. 3023
when the time comes 到时候 (dào shíhou)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 3023
When the Weather Turns
chapter topic; Chapter 514, p. 3925
When Wishes Come True
chapter topic; Chapter 536, p. 4087
where? 哪儿 (nǎr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 727
Where and When
chapter topic; Chapter 207, p. 1653
Where Is It?
chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 727
Where People Come From
chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 343
Where Things Are
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 719
which *nǎ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 343
which goes to show; so it is clear that 可见 (kějiàn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2835

which one *nǎge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 351
which ones 哪些 (nǎxiē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 1043
Which Way?
chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 2207; Chapter 283, p. 2207
white; pale 白 (bái)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 525
Who Did It
chapter topic; Chapter 310, p. 2433
Who Does What
chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 337
Whose Fault
chapter topic; Chapter 297, p. 4109
Whose Fault?
chapter topic; Chapter 539, p. 4109
Why?
chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 817
why? 为什么 (wèishénme)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 817
wife *qīzi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 2107
Win or Lose
chapter topic; Chapter 262, p. 2037
wind *fēng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 577
Wind and Warm Days
chapter topic; Chapter 218, p. 1725
window *chuānghu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1311
Winners
chapter topic; Chapter 501, p. 3829
Winning a Prize
chapter topic; Chapter 530, p. 4043
winter *dōngtiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 3931
With a Clock
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 843
with a mind at rest; settled 安心 (ānxīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2935
With a Tour Group
chapter topic; Chapter 434, p. 3337
with; and; (gēn ... yíyàng) the same as *gēn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1251

with good hopes of it; likely to happen 有望 (yǒuwàng)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 532, p. 4057
with one's own hands 亲手 (qīnshǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3917
witness *zhèngrén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2433
woman 女人 (nǚrén)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 321
woods; a grove *shùlín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3939
word of advice; warning *zhōnggào*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2835
words; speech 话 (huà)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 475
worker *gōngrén*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 685
world 世界 (shìjiè)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2547
worn out; fatigued *píláo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3707
would rather *nìngkě*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 534, p. 4073
wound; cut 伤口 (shāngkǒu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3663
wristwatch *shǒubiǎo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 971
writer; author 作家 (zuòjiā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 2017
Writing score — from sound, no model
script and writing topic; Chapter 17, p. 159
wrong; mistaken *cuò*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 1003
wronged; hurt by unfair blame *wěiqu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 3521

X

xǐhuan — 'to like', an ordinary verb with an ordinary object, and no inversion anywhere 喜欢 (xǐhuan)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 279
Xihuan — What You Like
chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 279

Y

year 年 (nián)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 429
year; grade (at school) *niánjí*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1935
yellow *huáng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 1135
Yes, but
chapter topic; Chapter 365, p. 2835
Yes, No, and a Tone That Moves
chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 51
yesterday *zuótiān*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 413
yet again; it happened again 又 (yòu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2469
yī → yí ge, yì tiān: the tone 一 takes
pronunciation topic; explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 88, p. 749
you all; you (more than one) 你们 (nǐmen)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 305
you (one person) 你 (nǐ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
you (polite) *nín*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 329
you're welcome; don't mention it 不客气 (bú kèqi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 663
you're welcome — real and understood everywhere, though not the commonest reply, which needs characters this book cannot yet print 不谢 (bú xiè)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 93
You Should Rest
chapter topic; Chapter 282, p. 2195
yǒu — 'to have', and also 'there is': one verb where Spanish spends three points 有 (yǒu)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 24, p. 239
You've Got a Point
chapter topic; Chapter 353, p. 2745
young *niánqīng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 807
young people; youth *qīngnián*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2687
younger brother *dìdi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 313

younger sister *mèimei*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 321
yuan; lump *kuài*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 957
yuan (the unit of money, as written; said kuài) 元 (yuán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1283

Z

zebra crossing; pedestrian crossing *bānmǎxiàn*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1559
zěnmeyàng — 'how is it?', the everyday way to ask how somebody is doing *zěnmeyàng*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 293
zero *líng*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 1083

Other

一 — one stroke, and that is the character
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 25
一家书店 — counting shops with 家
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 284, p. 2219
七 — two strokes, for seven
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 20, p. 199
万 — a bar, a turning hook, a long fall
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 393, p. 3039
三 — three bars, and the pattern's last stand
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 25
上 — the same rule, read the other way
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 7, p. 67
下 — a bar, a vertical, a dot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 73, p. 3105
不 — four strokes, all of them separate
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 41
不 — 没: two words for not
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 87, p. 737
世 — a long bar and two verticals
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 325, p. 2539
业 — two verticals, two short strokes, a long bar
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 487, p. 3727

东 — a bar, a turn, a hook and two short strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 203, p. 1623
两 — a bar, a frame, two small 人
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 88, p. 749
个 — three strokes, and you already write two of them
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 24, p. 239
中 — close, then pass through
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137
中国人 — a Chinese person, built out of three characters you already write 中国人 (Zhōngguó rén)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 221
为 — a dot, a long fall, the hook of 男, a dot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 95, p. 817
么 — three strokes, and one of them turns
script and writing topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, script; Chapter 9, p. 85
乐 — a fall, a turn, and 小
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 75, p. 647
九 — two strokes again
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 20, p. 199
也 — the right half of 他
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 92, p. 787
书 — a book, the book, books
grammar topic; Chapter 22, p. 221
书 — copy the compact route
script and writing topic; Chapter 18, p. 171
书 — two folds, upright, dot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 18, p. 171
书 — wait, then place the dot
script and writing topic; Chapter 18, p. 171
买 — a lid, two dots, and a cut-down 大
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 40, p. 375
了 — aspect, and why it is not a tense
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 25, p. 249
了 — two strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 25, p. 249
事 — a bar, 口, three bars and a long hook
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 167, p. 1369
二 — two bars, and neither is decoration
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 25
云 — two bars, then a turn and a dot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 219, p. 1733
五 — count the strokes and be wrong
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 25

些 — two small pieces over 二
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 127, p. 1043
交 — a lid, then two strokes crossing
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 408, p. 3149
亲 — the top of yì, then four strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 511, p. 3903
人 — two strokes, and a person walking
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 11
亻 — the same person, standing sideways
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 11
什 — both halves are old news
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 9, p. 85
今 — a roof, a dot and a turn
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 45, p. 413
从 — 人 twice, the left one narrower
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 155, p. 1271
从八点到十点 — from and to
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 155, p. 1271
他 — the person piece, then yě
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 31, p. 305
他比我大两岁 — comparing with 比
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 153, p. 1251
代 — the person piece, then a slanting hook
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 323, p. 2525
以 — four strokes in two pairs
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 126, p. 1035
以后我想... — later, I want to
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 287, p. 2253
们 — the person piece, then a doorway
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 31, p. 305
价 — the person piece, then 人 with two legs under it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 524, p. 3997
会 — 人 over two bars and a bend
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 76, p. 655
传 — the person piece, then two bars and a turning sweep
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 328, p. 2561
伤 — 亻, then a short top over 力
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 478, p. 3663
但 — the person piece, then the sun over a line
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 369, p. 2865
体 — the person piece, then 本
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 230, p. 1811

作 — **the person piece, then a post with two short bars**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 251, p. 1959
你去过中国吗 — **过 for what you have done**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 150, p. 1219
你在做什么 — **在 before a verb**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 149, p. 1209
你应该... — **you should**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 282, p. 2195
你说得很好 — **how well, with 得**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 152, p. 1241
保 — **the person piece, then 口 over a tree**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 382, p. 2957
信 — **the person piece, then a dot, three bars and 口**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 319, p. 2497
候 — **the person piece, a thin stroke, then the right side**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 173, p. 1411
假 — **the person piece, then two narrow pieces**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 263, p. 2043
做 — **the person, gǔ, and a striking hand**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 69, p. 601
停 — **the person piece, then a tall right side**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 418, p. 3219
偷 — **the person piece, then a roof over 月 and two posts**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 309, p. 2425
儿 — **fall, then bend and hook**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 12, p. 111
元 — **二, then 儿 under it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 156, p. 1283
先 — **a cross and a long bar, over 儿**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 269, p. 2085
先...然后...最后 — **first, then, last**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 278, p. 2147
光 — **three short strokes, a bar, then 儿**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 517, p. 3947
入 — **two strokes, the right one on top**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 405, p. 3127
全 — **a wide roof, then three bars and a vertical**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 381, p. 2949
八 — **a character you have already written twice**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 20, p. 199
公 — **八 over a turn and a dot**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 205, p. 1637

六 — **four strokes again, for six this time**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 20, p. 199
关 — **two short strokes over 天**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 198, p. 1589
兴 — **three short strokes over a bar, and 八 under it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 465, p. 3565
再 — **a bar, a frame, and a line that closes it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 59
写 — **a cover, then a turning hook**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 251, p. 1959
冷 — **the ice piece, then 今 and a dot**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 182, p. 1473
准 — **the ice piece, then the bird piece**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 364, p. 2827
出 — **two halves like 山, one long vertical**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 112, p. 943
到 — **至 on the left, then the blade of 前**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 151, p. 1229
前 — **horns, a bar, the moon and a blade**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 78, p. 669
力 — **a turn with a hook, then a falling stroke**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 474, p. 3635
包 — **a wrapping stroke, and three strokes inside**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 119, p. 989
北 — **two halves back to back**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 422, p. 3249
区 — **a bar, a cross, then the frame**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 377, p. 2921
医 — **a box open on the right, with five strokes inside**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 231, p. 1821
十 — **the character that was already here**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 20, p. 199
千 — **a short fall over 十**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 132, p. 1083
午 — **the top of 年**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 49, p. 447
半 — **two dots, two bars, one vertical**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 140, p. 1141
卖 — **十 on top, then 买 under it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 523, p. 3989
南 — **十 over a frame**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 423, p. 3257

原 — the cliff over 白 and 小
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 537, p. 4095
去 — a cross on a bar, and a corner below
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 43, p. 397
去...怎么走 — how do I get there?
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 283, p. 2207
又 — the fork at the foot of 报
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 315, p. 2469
发 — a bent stroke, a sweep, a fork and a dot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 291, p. 2291
取 — the ear piece, then 又
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 395, p. 3053
变 — a dot and a bar over four short strokes, then 又
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 386, p. 2987
口 — the box, on its own
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 41
古 — 十 over 口
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 321, p. 2511
只 — 口 over 八
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 399, p. 3083
叫 — a small mouth, then two strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 34, p. 329
可 — a bar, a mouth and a hook
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 365, p. 2835
号 — 口 on top, then a bar and a hook
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 189, p. 1521
司 — a hooked frame, a short bar, then kǒu
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 491, p. 3755
吃 — a mouth, then three strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 38, p. 359
吃了饭以后 — after doing something
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 278, p. 2147
同 — frame, line, box
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137
名 — a mouth with something above it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 75
后 — a three-stroke frame, then 口
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 147, p. 1187
吗 — copy it, and keep the mouth small
script and writing topic; Chapter 19, p. 185
吗 — the mouth, then the horse
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 19, p. 185

吗 — **wait, then write the bar**
script and writing topic; Chapter 19, p. 185
吵 — **口, then 少**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 129, p. 1059
呢 — **吗's shape, a different sound**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 26, p. 259
味 — **a small 口, then two bars and a vertical**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 449, p. 3449
和 — **eight strokes, and the right half is a mouth**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 27, p. 269
哪 — **口 beside the whole of 那**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 86, p. 727
喜 — **twelve strokes, stacked in four bands**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 28, p. 279
喝 — **a mouth, a sun and a wrap**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 39, p. 367
四 — **a box, and the rule that governs every box**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 3, p. 25
回 — **口 inside a larger frame**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 191, p. 1537
因 — **大 inside the frame of 国**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 96, p. 827
因为...所以... — **because, so**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 281, p. 2183
国 — **copy with the frame open**
script and writing topic; Chapter 17, p. 159
国 — **frame, inside, close**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 17, p. 159
国 — **wait before closing**
script and writing topic; Chapter 17, p. 159
图 — **a frame, and five strokes inside it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 454, p. 3487
在 — **the top of 有, a vertical, then 土**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 85, p. 719
地 — **the earth piece, then 也**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 207, p. 1653
场 — **the earth piece, then a zigzag and two sweeps**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 416, p. 3205
坐 — **人 twice, then 土**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 284, p. 2219
坐在这儿 — **在 after the verb**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 284, p. 2219

坐火车去 — going by train
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 284, p. 2219
城 — the earth piece, then 成
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 446, p. 3425
外 — the top of 多, then a vertical and a dot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 110, p. 927
多 — the same three strokes, twice
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 41, p. 957
大 — one bar, two falls
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 13, p. 121
天 — one more bar over 大
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 45, p. 413
太 — 大, then a dot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 93, p. 797
头 — two dots over a shape like 大
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 228, p. 1795
女 — three strokes, seated
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 11
好 again — proof, on a character you own, that tone is the word
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
如 — 女, then 口
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 281, p. 2183
如果...就... — if, then
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 289, p. 2273
如果...就会... — what would happen
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 289, p. 2273
妈 — the woman piece, then a horse
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 32, p. 313
子 — three strokes, a child
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 11
字 — a child under a roof
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 75
季 — the grain piece, then 子 under it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 515, p. 3931
学 — top, cover, child
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 13, p. 121
学了两年 — how long it lasted
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 286, p. 2243
孩 — 子, then a dot, a bar and four strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 253, p. 1975
安 — the roof of 家, then 女
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 379, p. 2935

定 — the roof of 安 over the foot of 是
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 390, p. 3015
客 — under the roof, a foot and 口
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 74, p. 637
家 — roof first, body second
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 12, p. 111
对 — five strokes, and a hand on the left
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 26, p. 259
小 — centre, left, right
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 131
少 — 小 without its hook, and a sweep
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 41, p. 957
尔 — a piece that is there for its sound
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 2, p. 11
就 — a dot, a bar, 口 and 小, then a four-stroke right side
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 288, p. 2263
山 — three peaks on a base
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 68, p. 593
岁 — six strokes, and a rule that is not left-to-right
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 27, p. 269
岛 — a top piece of four strokes, then 山
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 444, p. 3411
工 — two bars and a post
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 255, p. 1989
市 — a dot and a bar over three strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 448, p. 3441
希 — a cross, a bar and a long stroke, then three at the foot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 533, p. 4065
常 — three strokes, a cover, 口 and a cloth
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 178, p. 1445
年 — three bars and a long vertical
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 47, p. 429
庆 — the roof piece over 大
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 339, p. 2643
应 — the roof of 店, two dots, a falling stroke and a base
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 282, p. 2195
店 — a roof over a small piece and 口
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 190, p. 1529
开 — two bars, two legs
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 72, p. 621
当 — the top of 常, then the foot of 雪
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 287, p. 2253

往 — **the left piece of 很, then a dot over three bars**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 427, p. 3287
很 — **nine strokes, two pieces**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 30, p. 293
得 — **the left of 很, then 日, a bar and 寸**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 152, p. 1241
心 — **a dot, a lying hook, two dots**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 115, p. 963
必 — **the strokes of the heart, with a sweep through them**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 360, p. 2797
快 — **the upright heart, then guài**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 62, p. 541
怎 — **the right of 作, then 心**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 283, p. 2207
怕 — **the heart piece, then 白**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 463, p. 3549
思 — **a box with a cross, over the heart**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 347, p. 2701
性 — **the heart piece, then 生**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 467, p. 3581
怪 — **the upright heart, then 又 over the earth piece**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 539, p. 4109
情 — **the heart piece, then a top over 月**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 459, p. 3521
想 — **a tree and an eye, over a heart**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 55, p. 489
意 — **the left of 站 on top, then 日 and 心**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 280, p. 2173
感 — **a frame with 口 inside, then 心**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 286, p. 2243
愿 — **a cliff over 白 and 小, then 心**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 535, p. 4079
成 — **a bar, a fall, a small turn, then the slanting hook of 我**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 384, p. 2971
我 — **seven strokes, and an honest admission**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 75
我感觉... — **how it felt**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 286, p. 2243
我是 — **nothing agrees with anything**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 221
我是大学生了 — **something has changed**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 25, p. 249

我最喜欢... — **the one I like best**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 287, p. 2253
我的手机不见了 — **it's gone**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 285, p. 2231
我觉得... — **I think**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 280, p. 2173
房 — **a door over fāng**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 159, p. 1311
所 — **two four-stroke sides**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 281, p. 2183
手 — **a fall, two bars, a hook**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 52, p. 467
才 — **a bar, a hooked post and a sweep**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 313, p. 2455
打 — **the hand piece, then dīng**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 63, p. 2505
扫 — **the hand piece, then three bars**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 133, p. 1091
找 — **the hand piece, then a hook and a fall**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 197, p. 1581
找不到 — **can't find it**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 285, p. 2231
护 — **the hand piece, then the top of 房**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 443, p. 3403
报 — **the hand piece, then a hook, a post and a fork**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 293, p. 2305
改 — **a bent piece, then the right piece of 做**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 392, p. 3031
故 — **十 over 口, then the striking piece**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 297, p. 4109
救 — **a hooked post with small strokes, then the striking piece**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 298, p. 2343
教 — **the top of lǎo over zǐ, then four strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 493, p. 3769
文 — **copy with the route visible**
script and writing topic; Chapter 17, p. 159
文 — **wait, then open the two falls**
script and writing topic; Chapter 17, p. 159
文 — **watch four open strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 17, p. 159
新 — **two pieces on the left, one on the right**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 295, p. 2319

方 — **a dot over a bar, a hook and a long stroke**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 436, p. 3351
旅 — **a left piece of four strokes, then a right piece of six**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 403, p. 3111
日 — **one bar inside the box**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 41
早 — **sun on top, one more time**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 7, p. 67
时 — **日, then the right half of 对**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 97, p. 835
明 — **the sun beside the moon**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 47, p. 429
明天会下雨 — **会 for what will happen**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 147, p. 1187
星 — **日 above 生**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 46, p. 421
春 — **三 and 人 over 日**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 131, p. 3931
是 — **finish the sun, then build under it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 51
晚 — **日, then seven strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 49, p. 447
最 — **日, six strokes, then 又**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 278, p. 2147
月 — **the moon piece, standing on its own**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 148, p. 1197
有 — **six strokes, and a moon underneath**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 24, p. 239
望 — **a small piece and 月, then 王 under them**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 532, p. 4057
期 — **eight strokes, then the moon**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 46, p. 421
本 — **the tree piece, and a bar at its foot**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 104, p. 883
机 — **the tree piece, then jǐ**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 58, p. 511
村 — **the tree piece, then the right piece of 对**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 440, p. 3379
来 — **one piece, top to bottom**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 36, p. 343
杯 — **a tree piece, then 不**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 170, p. 1391

果 — **日, with 木 running through it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 289, p. 2273

树 — **the tree piece, 又, and three strokes on the right**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 516, p. 3939

校 — **the tree piece, then a lid and a cross**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 248, p. 1935

格 — **the tree piece, then the walking foot over 口**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 525, p. 4005

检 — **the tree piece, then a roof and what is under it**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 404, p. 3119

欢 — **six strokes, and two of them are already yours**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 28, p. 279

歌 — **kě twice, then four strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 504, p. 3851

正 — **一 on top, then the middle of 上 on a long bar**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 149, p. 1209

死 — **a long bar over two small pieces**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 300, p. 2357

母 — **a frame, two dots and a long bar**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 509, p. 3889

每 — **a fall and a bar over a dotted box**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 138, p. 1127

比 — **two halves side by side, the left one first**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 153, p. 1251

气 — **a fall, two bars, a hook**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 66, p. 577

水 — **the middle first, then the sides**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 39, p. 367

汉 — **copy with a five-part cue**
script and writing topic; Chapter 16, p. 147

汉 — **hold the route briefly**
script and writing topic; Chapter 16, p. 147

汉 — **watch five strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 16, p. 147

汉语 — **我看书: topic first, comment after**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 23, p. 229

没 — **water, a small roof, and 又**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 87, p. 737

河 — **the water piece, then 可**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 442, p. 3395

法 — **the water piece, then qù**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 349, p. 2715

洗 — **the water piece, then xiān**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 99, p. 847
活 — **the water piece, 千, then 口**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 302, p. 2373
海 — **the water piece, then 每**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 433, p. 3329
温 — **the water piece, then 日 over a dish**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 469, p. 3595
游 — **the water piece, a middle piece, then 子**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 431, p. 3315
火 — **two sparks around 人**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 72, p. 621
火车要开了 — **要 for what is coming**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 148, p. 1197
点 — **a mark on 口, over four dots**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 48, p. 439
热 — **the hand piece and a hooked bend, over four dots**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 258, p. 2009
然 — **a four-stroke piece, 大 with a dot, and four dots**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 278, p. 2147
爱 — **a hand on top, a cover, and 又 under them**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 461, p. 3535
父 — **two short strokes, then two long ones**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 507, p. 3873
牙 — **four strokes, each one different**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 473, p. 3627
特 — **the cow piece, then two pieces stacked**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 450, p. 3457
王 — **two bars, a vertical, a long bar**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 330, p. 2577
现 — **a narrow left piece, then 见**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 236, p. 1857
球 — **the jade piece, then seven strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 498, p. 3807
理 — **the jade piece, then lǐ**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 351, p. 2729
生 — **five measured strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 13, p. 121
用 — **the moon frame, two bars, a vertical**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 103, p. 875
电 — **日 with a long tail**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 63, p. 2505

男 — a field above, strength below
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 33, p. 321
画 — a bar, a field, an open box
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 502, p. 3835
界 — a field over 人
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 326, p. 2547
疼 — the frame of 病, and a shape of five inside
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 228, p. 1795
病 — the sickbed piece around a box
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 130, p. 1883
白 — a short fall over 日
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 60, p. 525
百 — a hundred, on a box you have built before
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 21, p. 213
的 — eight strokes for the commonest character there is
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 23, p. 229
...的时候 — when, and what was going on
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 279, p. 2159
看 — a hand above an eye
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 18, p. 171
看 — copy hand above, eye below
script and writing topic; Chapter 18, p. 171
看 — the verb that never changes
grammar topic; Chapter 22, p. 221
看 — wait, then recover the eye
script and writing topic; Chapter 18, p. 171
看书的人 — the one who reads
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 23, p. 229
看到 — 没看到: a verb and its result
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 151, p. 1229
看天气 — it depends on the weather
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 288, p. 2263
真 — ten, a box, a bar and two dots
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 358, p. 2783
眼 — an eye, then a right side of six
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 471, p. 3611
社 — the sign piece, then the earth piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 375, p. 2907
祝 — the spirit piece, then 口 over 儿
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 337, p. 2629
票 — a framed top over 二 and three strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 196, p. 1573

离 — **a cap, a box and a hooked frame**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 205, p. 1637
秋 — **the grain piece, then 火**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 342, p. 2667
突 — **the roof of 家, 八, then 大 with a dot**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 279, p. 2159
站 — **the standing piece, then a mark over 口**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 106, p. 897
笑 — **two small pieces over a short fall and 大**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 267, p. 2071
第 — **the bamboo piece of 笑, then a five-stroke body**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 279, p. 2159
米 — **a cross with two strokes above and two below**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 161, p. 1325
紧 — **two verticals and 又, over a silk piece ending in 小**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 481, p. 3687
红 — **the silk piece, then 工**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 334, p. 2605
约 — **the silk piece of 给, then a hook around a dot**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 388, p. 3001
级 — **the silk piece, then three strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 496, p. 3791
经 — **the silk piece, then a fork over 工**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 306, p. 2401
给 — **the silk piece, then 合**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 89, p. 761
网 — **the frame of 两, and two crosses**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 109, p. 919
老 — **a cross and a long fall, over the right half of 比**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 272, p. 2107
考 — **the top of lǎo, then two strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 494, p. 3777
职 — **an ear piece, then zhǐ**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 489, p. 3741
能 — **厶 over the moon piece, then two 匕**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 90, p. 2025
脸 — **月, then the right piece of 检**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 472, p. 3619
自 — **a short sweep over a tall frame**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 308, p. 2417
舞 — **eight strokes on top, then two pieces below**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 505, p. 3859

船 — **the boat piece, then 口 under a small frame**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 411, p. 3171
色 — **a small top piece, then a frame with a long hook**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 451, p. 3465
节 — **the grass piece over a hook**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 137, p. 1119
花 — **the grass piece over the person piece and two more strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 224, p. 1767
茶 — **grass, a roof, a small tree**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 166, p. 1361
草 — **the grass piece over 早**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 226, p. 1781
菜 — **the grass piece, a hand, the tree piece**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 101, p. 861
虽 — **a mouth over an insect**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 371, p. 2879
血 — **one short stroke over a dish**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 479, p. 3671
衣 — **a dot and a bar, then the body**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 165, p. 1353
西 — **a bar, a box and two strokes inside**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 231, p. 1821
要 — **the top of 西, then 女**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 91, p. 779
要是...就... — **if, then**
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 288, p. 2263
见 — **an eye on two legs**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 59
觉 — **three strokes, a cover, then 见**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 169, p. 1383
解 — **a horn, a knife and a cow**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 367, p. 2849
警 — **three pieces: top left, top right and the foot**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 311, p. 2439
讠 — **the speech radical**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 93
记 — **the speech piece, then the right piece of 起**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 304, p. 2387
试 — **the speech piece, then a slanting hook**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 108, p. 911
话 — **the speech piece, then a mouth**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 53, p. 475

该 — the left of 说, then the right of 孩
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 282, p. 2195
语 — copy, then fade
script and writing topic; Chapter 16, p. 147
语 — speech, five, box
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 16, p. 147
语 — wait, then write
script and writing topic; Chapter 16, p. 147
说 — the speech piece, then a mouth with legs
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 53, p. 475
请 — a half that tells you the sound
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 11, p. 103
读 — the speech piece, then 十 over 买
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 249, p. 1945
课 — the speech piece, then guǒ
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 79, p. 677
谢 — twelve strokes, and three pieces
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 93
赛 — a roof, a middle of seven strokes, a foot of four
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 500, p. 3821
走 — 土, then four strokes along the foot
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 283, p. 2207
起 — the walking piece, carrying jǐ
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 64, p. 1699
路 — the foot piece, then three strokes over 口
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 194, p. 1559
身 — a frame with two bars, crossed by two long strokes
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 230, p. 1811
车 — four strokes, the vertical last
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 44, p. 405
边 — the foot of 男, inside the walking piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 111, p. 935
过 — 寸, then the walking piece last
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 150, p. 1219
运 — 云 first, then the walking piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 529, p. 4035
还 — 不, then the walking piece last
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 154, p. 1261
这 — 文, then the walking piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 37, p. 351
进 — jǐng on the road piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 74, p. 637

送 — 关 in the walking piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 336, p. 2621
通 — the right piece first, then the walking piece under it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 409, p. 3157
速 — a bundle, then the walking piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 421, p. 3241
道 — a head piece, then the walking piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 353, p. 2745
那 — four strokes, then an ear
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 37, p. 351
部 — five strokes over 口, then the right piece of 那
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 438, p. 3365
都 — 者, then the ear on the right
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 94, p. 807
酒 — the water piece, then a jar
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 425, p. 3273
里 — 日, a line through it, two bars
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 81, p. 691
重 — a fall and a bar over 里
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 134, p. 1099
量 — 日, a long bar, then 里
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 526, p. 4015
钱 — the metal piece, then two bars and a hook
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 188, p. 1513
错 — the metal piece, then a cross-bar over the sun
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 356, p. 2767
长 — four strokes in one piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 61, p. 533
门 — a dot, a post, a frame
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 65, p. 567
问 — 门 with 口 inside
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 65, p. 567
间 — 门 with 日 inside
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 181, p. 1465
阳 — the ear piece on the left, then 日
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 518, p. 3955
难 — a narrow 又, then the bird piece
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 397, p. 3069
雨 — a lid, a frame and four drops
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 66, p. 577
雪 — 雨 on top, three bars below
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 221, p. 1747

静 — **the right piece of 情, then a right side of six**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 466, p. 3573
面 — **a bar, a short stroke, then a frame**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 175, p. 1425
音 — **five strokes over 日**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 128, p. 1051
须 — **three sweeps, then the page piece**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 362, p. 2811
题 — **shì, then the page piece**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 354, p. 2753
风 — **a frame, and two short strokes inside**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 218, p. 1725
飞 — **a hooked turn, then two small strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 413, p. 3185
饭 — **the food piece, then four strokes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 38, p. 359
饼 — **the food piece, then two bars and two legs**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 341, p. 2659
马 — **a turn, a zigzag, a base**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 67, p. 1761
高 — **a lid, 口, then a frame around a small 口**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 248, p. 1935
鬼 — **a box with long legs**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 332, p. 2591